

LUGHAT-UL-QURAN

DICTIONARY OF QURAN

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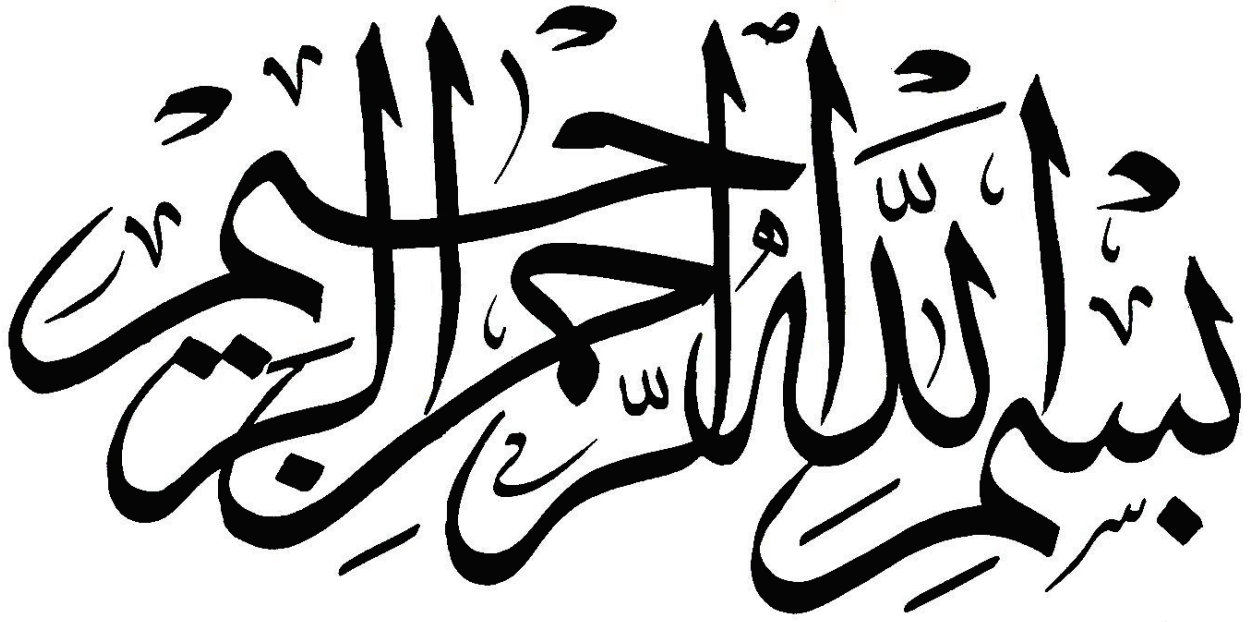
VOLUME I

Ebook edition

Originally compiled in Urdu by
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Published by: Quranic Education Society, Oslo - Norway

In association with Tolu-e-Islam Trust, Lahore - Pakistan

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Translators note

The journey of translating Lughat-ul-Quran into English has been a long one.

It all started several years ago when **Liaqat Ali** and **Saim Khawaja** in USA felt the need to have the dictionary of the Quranic terms translated from Urdu to English. For this great task, they contacted and hired **Javed Rafiq**, a retired journalist in Karachi, who took on the job to translate this book from Urdu to English. Our friends in the USA compensated his time against an agreed fee. **Javed Rafiq** had never done any translation work of such kind before, and was not familiar with the teachings and philosophy of **Allama Ghulam Ahmad Parwez** in relation to the Quran.

This was clearly reflected in the early pages of his translation, but gradually he improved the translation as he moved along. This work was done gradually and handed over in parts to our contacts in the USA. When all the work was done, **Liaqat Ali** distributed it to others around the world. Some held on to it for their study, while some of this translation ended up on the internet.

However, this work never got published in a book form because of several reasons. Many people felt that the work was not satisfying, and the English did not meet the desired quality and fluency. There were many linguistic, as well as cosmetic changes required. There were many missing sentences, paragraphs/pages, without any clear overview. Many readers had this opinion that the standard of the translation required review and needed thorough editing in order to make it readable and comprehensible for the western and the wider readership.

Dr. Sohail Alam (son of **Dr. Mansoor Alam**) was one of many who had the opinion that to re-write the whole book could be better and quicker time wise than editing grammatically the English translation of **Javed Rafiq**. The limitation was that although **Dr. Sohail's** English was excellent (as seen in the introduction chapter to this book) he had very little time for the complete translation.

All this contributed to the delay in the publication of this translation and the whole project came to a standstill.

I got more determined to have this book translated in English without knowing the above mentioned background. My quest for the Quranic knowledge had convinced me that in order to understand the Quran, some basic knowledge of the Arabic grammar is helpful and also knowing the root meanings of the Arabic words/terms. When I found out about the Lughat-ul-Quran, I was pleasantly surprised that such a marvelous piece did exist. I accepted this challenge to complete the translation work into English. For any serious student of the Quran this is an extremely useful book and it needed to be published in English to enhance the Quranic understanding, as its author always intended. To make this happen, it was essential to present it to people on a global basis. I myself had tried to understand several chapters of the Quran by studying the Lughat-ul-Quran, but in order to present arguments in support of my understanding; I had to present the Lughat-ul-Quran in a language that other researchers of Truth may find useful.

Since I became a member of the Quranic Education Society in Norway, I wanted to present the Quran to people in a language they could understand. When I suggested that the Lughat-ul-Quran should be translated into English, our chairman **Khadim Malik** agreed instantly. We both agreed on the importance of this dictionary to be presented to wider public in English. Later we found out that a preliminary translation had already been done earlier, and learnt that the project was on hold for some reason. We were fortunate that the late **Farhat Maqbool** (London Bazrn) provided us with all the material on the work which had been done so far. This saved us a lot of time. The translated material I got was not in a presentable form by any means. The layout was poor, the grammar was not always correct, and some spelling errors were also present. The biggest limitation was of the Arabic text. I started to refine this translation. I knew that some pages were missing and hence translated those later. Another major concern with this initial translation was that it was done by someone who was not fully familiar with the philosophy of the Quran as explained by **Allama Parwez**. The translator was merely translating without

understanding, and therefore the literal translation did not do justice to the original Urdu version, and I had to take this into consideration.

After completion, I got the help of **Khalid Sayed** and **Ejaz Rasool** (London Bazm) who went through all four volumes very thoroughly and made further corrections while reviewing the draft and ensuring to keep the explanations closer to the Urdu version, especially where human thought process was referred.

Now this work has been finalised, and we can appreciate and take advantage of the final product. I have included my name as the main editor of this translation for convenience and for any correspondence, but I would like to acknowledge the contributions of all those who helped to put this together.

To conclude I would like to summarise the names of all the brothers who took part in this great challenge and helped to complete it successfully:

- **Liaqat Ali** and **Saim Khawaja** in USA, who initiated the translation work.
- **Javed Rafiq** in Karachi, who did the preliminary translation.
- **Farhat Maqbool** from London Bazm who provided me the raw material and encouragement.
- **Khadim Malik** of Quranic Education Society Norway who helped and provided encouragement.
- **Khalid Syed** of London Bazm, who helped to review some part of the dictionary and also kept encouraging and motivating me.
- **Ejaz Rasool** of London Bazm who reviewed the remaining part of the dictionary where **Khalid Syed** had handed over.

Finally, I am sure this book will help many English readers to understand the Quran, like the Urdu version enhanced my understanding of the Quranic Truth.

My only regret is that this project did not come to fruition in the lifetime of late **Farhat Maqbool**, who would have appreciated it as he showed great desire to see this project through.

My father, late **Mahmood Ahmad Akhtar**, who was a long time devotee of the ToluIslam movement and the real reason behind my inspiratoin and interest in the Quranic study in the first place, would also have been very pleased with this work. They will get their rewards from Allah.

On a last note, I fully appreciate the work done for the Urdu edition by **Allama Ghulam Ahmad Parwez**, who did all the work mostly by himself, where he researched several books to help create such an exceptional encyclopaedia of the Quranic words and terms. It took him many years to research to write the Urdu version. I am grateful to Allah for giving strength and knowledge to **Allama Ghulam Ahmad Parwez** to publish the Urdu work which helped many like myself and others to spread the Quranic message for the good of mankind for all times to come. He will be getting his reward from Allah.

It should also be mentioned that the names of the messengers has been written as they appear in the Quran, and not the biblical way which is commonly known for English readers. This has been done to keep the Quranic terms under focus. All messengers are sacred to us and we do not distinguish between them with regards to respect and status (2:136). The term "peace be upon him" has not allway been used after messenger's names, but it is implied.

Finally, let us all keep making effort to understand the Quran and benefit from its guidance.

Sincerely

Sheraz Akhtar
Quranic Education Society Oslo - Norway

Note: The ebook version has four volumes as the original book, while the printed version only has two volumes with following ISBN: 978-1506147468 and 978-1506147468

Introduction

"The correct and the only meaning of the Quran lies, and is preserved, within itself, and a perfect and detailed exegesis of its words is within its own pages. One part of the Quran explains the other. It needs neither philosophy, nor wit, nor lexicography, nor even hadith.".... Inayat Allah Khan Mashriqi

The Quran, the final book of revelation from Allah, comprises the sole complete system of life for all mankind. This system, based on the deep eternal laws that govern and hold the fabric of our universe together, is not affected by the changing winds of time. It is so comprehensive that it encompasses, in every era, all facets of human existence, leading the charge in the quest for knowledge and wisdom. Consequently, a book with such far-ranging capabilities must be of a language that is equally comprehensive, deep, and capable of conveying the most complex and abstract thought, while at the same time maintaining clarity and precision.

Upon reflection, it becomes evident that since Allah had chosen the Arab nation to inherit and implement the revolutionary message of the Quran, then even centuries before the actual revelation of the Quran, the Arabs had a tremendous responsibility to; step by step evolve a language that would be capable of expressing and containing its wisdom. When Abraham's children were split into two branches, one branch (***Bani Israel***) received continuous revelation through the Messengers and gained authority throughout the land, whereas the other branch (***Bani Ishmael***) was settled in the barren deserts of Arabia, where following Ishmael, they received no more messengers or revelation, nor any power or authority. This apparently forgotten branch, however, bit by bit, maturing and growing in the arms of nature, grew into a nation that would hold the honour of being the first people to address the final message delivered by the final Messenger, in their own language.

These people held their tongue in such high regard that they called themselves ***Arabs*** (meaning clear in speech) and others ***Aajam*** (meaning mute). The word Arab means clean, clear and precise. An important point, however, is that during the centuries that ***Bani-Israel*** was occupied with the development of their civilization to the heights of their ancient world (including the glorious reigns of David and Solomon), their brothers, ***Bani Ishmael***, for this entire period, either consciously or subconsciously, were engaged and occupied with the arrangement and development of a language that had no peer in the entire world. In the literature of linguistic scientists, one can find a claim that to estimate the intellectual capacity of a nation at a given time; one should examine their language to determine how many of their words are conceptual. Regarding the Indo-European languages, their research was that "every thought that has passed through the mind of India may be reduced to 121 root-concepts" (***Max Mueller***). When Sanskrit was a living language, at a time when the sun and fire were considered deities, there were a total of 37 words for sun and 35 words for fire.

Now let us compare that with the language of the Arabs. These desert dwellers had 80 words for honey, 200 for snake, 500 for lion, 1000 for sword, and for a camel they had a total of 5, 744 words (Cosmic Consciousness). These facts illustrate the depth of conceptual thought and the wide range of expression of which the Arabic language was capable. This was the language in which the Quran was revealed.

(26:192)	And verily this Quran is a revelation from the Sustainer of all the worlds	وَإِنَّهُ لَتَنْزِيلُ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ
(26:193)	The Spirit, faithful to the trust, has descended with it	نَزَلَ بِهِ الرُّوحُ الْأَمِينُ
(26:194)	On thy heart, that thou may be a Warner	عَلَى قَلْبِكَ لِتَكُونَ مِنَ الْمُنذِرِينَ
(26:195)	In plain and clear Arabic tongue	بِلِسَانٍ عَرَبِيٍّ مُبِينٍ

This illustrates the position of Arabic vis-à-vis the Quran. As far as the Quran itself, it is written:

(12:2) (43:2)	We have made it a Book to be oft read in clear, eloquent language that you may understand	إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَاهُ قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا لَعَلَّكُمْ تَعْقِلُونَ
(20:113)	Thus have We revealed it as an Arabic Quran (<i>Quraanan Arabiyyan</i>). In it, we turned around and turned on the warnings, so people may show understanding, or that it may create reflection in them.	وَكَذَلِكَ أَنْزَلْنَاهُ قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا وَصَرَّفْنَا فِيهِ مِنَ الْوَعِيدِ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَتَّقُونَ أَوْ يُحْدِثُ لَهُمْ ذِكْرًا
(39:28)	An Arabic Quran, without any ambiguity, so they had to meet understanding.	قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا غَيْرَ ذِي عِوَجٍ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَتَّقُونَ
(18:01)	Praise be to Allah, Who revealed the font for its contractor, and it contains no ambiguity or uncertainty, but is straight and erect,	الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي أَنْزَلَ عَلَى عَبْدِهِ الْكِتَابَ وَلَمْ يَجْعَلْ لَهُ عِوَجًا
(41:3)	this is a book whose verses are well-defined and able to be analysed separately, allowing the Quran precisely to clarify itself for those who undertake its study with knowledge and insight	كِتَابٌ فَصَّلَتْ آيَاتُهُ قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ

The key words in the above verses are "***Quraanan Arabiyyan***" (see also 42:7, 46:12).

The term "***Quraanan Arabiyyan***" can be interpreted in two ways.

- The general understanding is "an Arabic Quran", i.e. on the Arabic language, but
- It can also be understood as "a Quran which explains itself very clearly and precisely." This is with regard to the meaning of the word ***Arabi***.

This has often been repeated throughout the Quran also says phrases like "***Hukman Arabiyyan***" Thus, a clear and precise judgment. (13:37).

- The 39:28 is the clarity of the Quran underlined in the statement of "***ghaira dhei i'waji***," which says that it does not contain any ambiguity.
- This is repeated at 6:01 p.m., "***wa lam yaj'al Lahu i'waja***," and it contains no ambiguity and uncertainty.
- This point is further elaborated in 41:3, which says that this is a book where the verses are well defined and able to be analysed separately. To prepare the Quran itself for making their assessment of knowledge and insight.

(39:28)	An Arabic Quran, that does not contain any ambiguity	قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا غَيْرَ ذِي عِوَجٍ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَتَّقُونَ
(18:01)	Praise be to Allah, Who revealed the font for its contractor, and it contains no ambiguity or uncertainty, but straight and tall,	الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي أَنْزَلَ عَلَى عَبْدِهِ الْكِتَابَ وَلَمْ يَجْعَلْ لَهُ عِوَجًا
(41:3)	a Book, whose word is prepared as an Arabic Koran, for people with insight.	كِتَابٌ فَصَّلَتْ آيَاتُهُ قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ

The values espoused in the Quran, lofty and sublime though may be, have still been elaborated and described in a simple manner.

(44:58)	Verily, We have made this (Quran) easy, in thy tongue, in order that they may give heed.	فَإِنَّمَا يَسَّرْنَاهُ بِلِسَانِكَ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَتَذَكَّرُونَ
(54:17)	And We have indeed made the Quran easy to understand and remember: then is there any that will receive admonition?	وَلَقَدْ يَسَّرْنَا الْقُرْآنَ لِلذِّكْرِ فَهَلْ مِنْ مُدَكِّرٍ

Based on the above observations, it is evident that the Quran asserts that it is sent in a clear and easily understood Arabic tongue. One might then conclude that a native speaker of Arabic, therefore, would

easily be able to comprehend even its deepest principles. Practical experience though, reveals that this is definitely not the case. Undoubtedly, a grasp of the Arabic language is a prerequisite for interpreting the Quran (no book in the world can be understood without knowing the language it was written in), but if that was all that was required, then native speakers of Arabic would automatically become experts of Quranic knowledge. We will not discuss here the extent to which Arabs understand Quranic principles (this includes not only the general Arab populous but also the educated and the scholars). When this is the situation with native Arabic speakers, one can only imagine the multiplication of difficulties for non-Arabs.

This observation raises a vital question: why is it that the Quran describes itself as a clear, easily understood book in a clear Arabic tongue, yet very few of those who are native Arabic speakers or have learned Arabic seem truly to comprehend Quranic teachings? The answer is crucially important, a firm grasp of which is of the utmost importance in arriving at the true Quranic message.

The pre-Islamic Arabs possessed a culture with much greater affinity for poetry than prose, and that was the medium in which their entire linguistic treasure was passed on from generation to generation. In contrast, what today is called “Arabic literature” was primarily composed during the Abbasid period, the same period during which were compiled the various books of hadith, Quranic *tafseer*, history and biography. Many volumes of Arabic literature, grammar and linguistic science were produced and extensive Arabic lexicons were compiled. It is quite interesting and ironic that all these works (with few exceptions) that comprise the earliest written or prose literature of the Arabic language were actually produced by non-Arabs.

The student of history would be well aware that during the Abbasid period of Islamic history, numerous foreign concepts began to permeate all facets of life. These foreign concepts influenced and shaped society in ways that ripened the climate for the seizure of political power by the Abbasids. Their politics were infused with these new foreign concepts and ideals, further helping to perpetuate them. It is only natural that once this happened, tremendous political pressure would then be applied to inculcate these ideals into every other facet of society. It is precisely because of this fact that the literary products of that time, despite their outward appearance of Arabic form, were actually foreign/non-Arabic in their inner true nature. This is how the Arabic language, in the earliest stages of its systematization and study, was turned into a vehicle of non-Arabic ideals. A more formal description and study of this phenomenon has been excellently provided in the work of the late *Ahmed Amin Misri*, “*Fajr al-Islam*.” In it, he claims “Undoubtedly, you will agree with me that Persian literature had cast Arabic literature in a new light.”

It follows that once the meanings of Arabic words were affected in this manner, as expected, the understanding and interpretation of the Arabic words of the Quran were impacted as well. Since the books of Quranic interpretation (*tafseer*) were compiled during this period, they too became prey to these external influences. This is how the Arabic words of the Quran came to take on altogether different meanings than the ones existing at the time of its revelation. In addition to this general external (*Aajami*) influence upon Arabic, there was also another very important reason leading to this mutation of meanings.

When the first books of Quranic exegesis were compiled in the 3rd and 4th century A. H., one major technique used to interpret any important verse of the Quran was to examine its so-called “*sabab nuzool*,” the reason for the revelation of the verse as recorded in narratives. These narratives would claim that some matter would come to pass, and in answer, a verse of the Quran would then be revealed. In this way, the stories ascribed to a Quranic verse became a more important focus of commentary than the actual words of the Quran. As a result, the meanings of the Arabic words in those Quranic verses were shaped and moulded to fit the narrations ascribed to it. As time went on, newer books of *tafseer* would not dare depart too far from the original and oldest books, and in this way, this style of Quranic commentary was perpetuated through history, gaining a semblance of credence and authority. By claiming the narrations, and hence, the exegesis sprang from none other than the mouths of the beloved Messenger(s) and his companions, these *tafseer* were made all the more irrefutable. All of this is in spite of the fact that the majority of the involved narrations are weak or unreliable (according to the hadith sciences), leading the occasional frustrated scholar, such as *Ahmad Ibn Hanbal*, to lament that “narrations of war and slaughter and *tafseer* are totally unreliable.” Despite these facts, these narrations continue to dominate books on Quranic commentary and its resulting philosophy; therefore, it is not difficult to conceive that if these

untrustworthy narrations are the basis for determining the meaning of a Quranic verse and of the Arabic words used in that verse, this would lead to a distortion of the true meanings of the words, thus obscuring the true meaning of the verse from the eyes of the reader.

This point is best explained through a specific example in the Quran.

(04:34)	Men are in charge of women, because Allah hath made the one of them to excel the other... (<i>Pickthall</i>)	الرِّجَالُ قَوَّامُونَ عَلَى النِّسَاءِ بِمَا فَضَّلَ اللَّهُ بَعْضَهُمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ وَمَا أَنْفَقُوا مِنْ أَمْوَالِهِمْ
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Here, the word “*qawwaamoon*” is taken to mean “in charge of,” even though according to the language, the meaning is “those who provide the daily bread.” This latter meaning implies that there is a division of labor between men and women, and men are duty-bound to earn a means of living for the family. So how did the meaning shift from provider to dominator or ruler?

A glance at one of the most highly authoritative books of *tafseer*, written by *Ibn-Kathir*, will shed light on exactly how this transformation of meaning took place. In his *tafseer* of the above verse, *Ibn Kathir* relates various accounts connected to the revelation of this verse.

Ibn Abbas claimed that “*qawwamoon*” refers to the fact that women should obey men... *Hasal al-Basri* relates a story in which a woman came complaining to the Messenger that her husband had struck her. Just as the Messenger was about to pronounce that her husband should be punished, the above Quranic verse was revealed, and then the Messenger said that there would be no punishment for her husband... In another narration, a man and his wife came before the Messenger. The woman complained to the Messenger that her husband had struck her and there was still a mark on her face. Just as the Messenger began to say that the husband should not have done so, the above verse was revealed. Upon this, the Messenger claimed “I willed something but Allah willed something else.”

...There is a hadith in which the Messenger is reported to have said “Don’t beat Allah’s slave women (referring to women in general).” Thereafter *Umar* came to him and said “Oh Messenger! Having heard your command, the women have become bold towards their husbands.” Upon hearing this, the Messenger allowed the beating of women. When the men began beating their wives, many complaints arose from the women to the Messenger. The Messenger then said “Many women have appealed to me complaining of their husbands’ abuse. Those men are not the best of you.” ... *Ishat ibn Qays* relates “I was once a guest of *Umar*. It happened that an argument broke out between him and his wife, and he hit her. He then said to me ‘Ishat, remember three things I will tell you that I learned from the Messenger. Do not ask a man why he beats his wife, do not go to sleep until you have prayed the *Witr* prayer, and I have forgotten the third (i.e. the narrator could not recall the third) ... In one narration, the Messenger is reported to have said “If I could have ordered that any person bow to another person, I would have ordered the women to bow to their husbands because of the tremendous weight of right the husband has upon her.”

So as one can see, traditional Quranic commentary made on the basis of narration and tradition changed the meaning of the word “*qawwamoon*” to mean ruler or dominator, perhaps even something beyond that. This interpretation is not unique to *Ibn Kathir* but is repeated in other works as well, such as *Zamakhshari’s al-Kashshaaf*, in which he equates “*qawwamoon*” with “*musaytireen*” (dominators or overlords). In *tafsir Jalaalayn*, the synonym “*mutasalliteen*” is used, in other words those who control, command and rule women. With such a predominance of this interpretation, not surprisingly, this meaning of “*qawwamoon*” eventually worked its way into books of language, eventually pervading the literature of the Islamic world and the education of Islamic scholars and the masses. In this way, Arabic speakers and Arabs alike lost touch with the true message of the Quran.

These facts lead us towards a very important question, that:

If the Arabic language was tainted in the Abbasid period by non-Arabs and, If all the Arabic works (tafseer, history, lexicons, or literature) that we possess today were produced in that era (usually by non-Arabs), plus the fact that the books of tafseer used unreliable narrations to fortify the incorrect usage and meaning of Arabic words, Then how can there be any possibility of recovering the true meaning of Arabic words, as understood at the time of the revelation of the Quran?

This question is answered with the following points.

1. If this happened in any other language (or to any other book), there is no doubt that the above difficulties would be insurmountable; however, certain elements of the Arabic language (and the Quran) allow a solution to this challenging problem. Firstly, as was mentioned above, the entirety of the Arabic language was contained within the works of poetry prevalent in pre-Islamic Arabia. Poets had a special status in that society, as their poetry was often used to extol the virtues of a tribe as well as to degrade and humiliate enemy tribes. As such, these poems were a heritage of a tribe and were taught even to its children. Prose, when transmitted orally, is difficult to protect from gradual alterations as the narrators pass the message onwards adding their own understanding and/or wording. This is because the form is not considered important in prose, only the meaning. Poetry, however, is quite different since the form and meaning are both integrated in the work. Thus, whenever poetry is learned and memorized, it is always transmitted forward with its form intact.

This is how and why pre-Islamic Arabic poetry was preserved until the time of the Abbasids, when it was finally compiled into writing. Undoubtedly though, numerous apocryphal works of poetry were also created during the Abbasid period and were mixed in with genuine pre-Islamic poetry; however, this should not impede our purpose since that poetry must have used exactly the same language (both form and vocabulary) as true pre-Islamic poetry, otherwise the counterfeits would be immediately discovered. Thus, pre-Islamic Arabic poetry was eventually preserved in the various books of Arabic literature, the analysis of which allows deduction of the pre-Islamic usage of Arabic words. The way in which Arabic words were used in that poetry is largely how the Quran uses it (and would have been how the Arabs at the time of the Quran's revelation would have understood it).

Pre-Islamic poetry, in addition to being preserved in books of Arabic literature, are also documented in the various Arabic lexicons. These works make use of pre-Islamic poetry in an attempt to systematically derive the original meanings of the words. These lexical works are of great value in understanding the Quran the way it would have been understood at the time of its revelation.

2. Above is a description of how to arrive at the true pre-Islamic meaning of Arabic words using external literary sources; however, the Arabic language also has a tremendously useful internal characteristic that both protects the meanings of words from external forces of change as well as aids one in determining the true meaning of a particular word. Arabic words are all constituted from a single root. The essence of the meaning is contained within the root and regardless of how its appearance may change according to the rules of grammar; its derivatives will always be inextricably bound to the essence of that root (It is this very characteristic that allows Arabic to continue to create new words through time as the need arises. For this, one need only find the appropriate root meaning and consider its various grammatical derivations; there would be no concept for which an appropriate word could not be generated.) To take this concept a step further, not only are words based on a fundamental root meaning, but even within root meanings, it is known that if certain letters appear in that root (such as HA and BA) then that group of roots will have related meanings, or if the root contains another two letters (such as SAAD and RA) then another group of related roots will result. Such a high degree of hierarchical and derivational vocabulary results in an unparalleled level of protection from the adulteration of the language. If, through the winding passage of time, a word changes in meaning or usage, it will be immediately discovered against the backdrop of its relatives within which are preserved the changed word's

original meaning. This is how one can analyse the various words of the Quran to arrive at the meanings that would have been prevalent among the pre-Islamic Arab society at the time of its revelation.

3. The third element that helps us to rediscover Arabic is actually a result of the very simple and plain lives of the pre-Islamic Arabs. They lived with an expansive sky above their heads decorated by the sun, moon, and the twinkling of the stars, a vast desert before them with never-ending dunes, the landscape occasionally punctuated by mountains, streams of water with lush growth of greenery serving as oases of life in the barren desert, providing its dwellers with date palms and occasionally grapevines and pomegranate trees. Near these oases, one might find the tents of these desert dwellers, serving to house their meagre few precious possessions, of which the most prized are their weapons, swords, arrows, bows, spears, shields, and daggers. With their few camels, horses, cattle and goats grazing in the sparse meadows nearby, this simple life comprised the entire sphere of existence for those simple desert dwelling Arabs of that forgotten time. This atmosphere is what served as the basis for the development of their entire language; in other words, their vocabulary evolved from the simple concrete and perceptible things around which their whole lives were based, and this is why the words used to describe them are comprehended and even visualized easily. Confusion and ambiguity in meaning usually arise in relation to the abstract, immaterial or philosophical, which are of little use in the harsh conditions of the desert. Indeed, it is the pure and simple language of the desert Bedouins that is considered the purest Arabic tongue.

The way in which the fundamental meaning of a root can be brought to light by the practical use of the word by desert Arabs is best illustrated by an example.

(2:153)	O you, who believe, seek help in patience (Sabre) and <i>Salaat</i> . God is with those with patience (<i>Sabireen</i>).	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اسْتَعِينُوا بِالصَّبْرِ وَالصَّلَاةِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَ الصَّابِرِينَ
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SABR, commonly translated as patience, is usually applied to a situation from which an individual cannot escape, leading to desperation and helplessness. When there is no hope of actively affecting the situation, the advice given is “has patience,” to the extent that even someone suffering great injustice at the hands of another, when he can do nothing to improve the situation, calms his inner struggle through the mantra of “patience.” In other words, this interpretation of “*sabr*” carries a connotation of passivity.

The root meaning of **SABR**, however, is constantly and continuously to struggle towards a goal or purpose, to stand steadfastly. This root meaning is derived based on its usage by the desert Arabs in their daily lives. In other words, it means a connotation of activity.

A part of a cloud, if it stays in exactly the same spot for 24 hours without apparently shifting, is called **AS-SABEER**. **AL-ASBIRAH** is the word used to describe camels or goats that leave during the day to graze, and later return retracing their footsteps exactly, without a single one of them going astray or being left behind {*T*}. These concrete examples allow one to visualize how the Arabs understood **SABR** to mean steadfastness, persistence and perseverance, to firmly adhere to a principle or way, commitment to an action. It is this unshakable resolution towards a way or principle that was considered **SABR** by the Arabs.

Moving on, if passengers or goods created an uneven balance on a boat such that it begins to be unstable, the boatman would place a heavy rock in order to balance the load. This rock would be called **AS-SABOORAH** {*T*}. Therefore, the second characteristic of **SABR** is that if one’s footsteps begin to waver from the path, it is **SABR** that provides the support upon which balance is regained, keeping the footsteps firmly on the chosen path. Because this kind of steadfastness leads to success and accomplishment, **AS-SABRAH** is used to describe a pile of grain that is unmeasured (*Muheet*).

In the face of the forces of change through time, the aforementioned features of Arabic greatly facilitate arriving at the true, original meanings of words; however, while the above form a fundamental basis for

the meanings that is inescapable, there is yet another level of depth to attaining the full and true meaning of a book like the Quran. The reason for this is that this book is an outline for the eternal values of life, unchanging and all-encompassing upon whose truths our entire belief is based. It is, therefore, necessary that its understanding be complete and without doubt, something that can be difficult to attain if relying purely on the language as mentioned above.

Language (or linguistic science) is the product of human efforts, and thus, is inherently open to mistakes and external influences. In addition, there are certain words that the Quran uses as a form of terminology. These terms represent very important core Quranic principles and concepts cannot be adequately elucidated by pure language alone.

For example, **SALAT, ZAKAT, TAQWA, IMAN, ISLAM, KUFR, FISQ**, etc. all these terms are a comprehensive condensation of fundamental Quranic concepts that contain depth beyond (but linked to) their linguistic understanding. By carefully studying the whole Quran, linguistic ambiguities can be eliminated and the full extent of the terminological meanings can be brought to light.

As far as how this is achieved in practice, one must bear in mind that the Quran is written in such a way that if a topic is mentioned in one place, it often will be further alluded to in another place in such a way that the former is clarified. The Quran refers to this as “*tasreef-ul-ayaat*.” This means that a topic is brought back in several verses in such a way that the complete meaning of the concept emerges.

Hence, whether for an Arabic word or for specific Quranic terminology, the true meaning may be found by bringing all the pertinent Quranic verses together within which the word is found.

Based on what has been discussed above, it is evident that to determine the meaning of a word:

1. One must first identify and study the root meaning and characteristics, keeping in mind that despite however much the appearance of the word changes, it generally carries within it the essence of the root.
2. The word must be viewed in terms of how the simple desert Arabs employed it in their daily lives. By taking those concrete examples, one can often deduce how those folk conceptualized the word. It should be kept in mind that until the concept behind a word is discovered, one cannot truly understand the meaning of the word. The modern science of semantics has shed tremendous light on this area. This particular branch of linguistics is of great value in attaining the deepest possible understanding of a word.
3. All the passages of the Quran containing the word should be investigated to determine the various shades of meaning attached to it. By doing this, one can develop an understanding of the Quranic concept for that word.
4. Most importantly, one must keep in mind the overall teaching of the Quran. It should always be borne in mind that the Quran’s vocabulary and terminology should not be contrary to its basic teachings because the Quran also declares that it contains no contradictions (e.g. that if multiple meanings are possible linguistically, ones that lead to contradictions should be avoided. This does not imply that meanings of words should be changed in order to avoid contradictions, thus making it a self-fulfilling claim.). This is only truly possible when one frees his or her mind of all external biases and concentrates on deriving the meaning of the Quran in its own light. Allah has declared that the Quran is a guiding light (*Noor*), and light has no need for external sources to make itself manifest.

Using the mentioned techniques, the true meaning of the Quranic words and passages can be understood.

In this connection, *Allama Jamaluddin Afghani*’s student, and the teacher of *Syed Rashid Raza*, *Imam Sheikh Mohammad Abdohu* has written a book *Tafseerul Manar*. We present certain elements from this book’s foreword, with respect to high standards of understanding Quran.

The first step is to understand the meaning of individual words. One needs to understand how words were used by the ancient Arabs and not depend on anyone’s explanation or understanding as to what they mean today. But it is also essential to not depend solemnly upon this, because many words were used to express

certain meanings during the revelation of the Quran, but later with passage of time, they began to mean something else. One example is the word "**taweel**" which has come to mean explanation, but the Quran uses it for a different meaning, which is of being the final result, or the result of Quranic promises. It is essential for a researcher to investigate the original meaning of a word, as compared to its current use which appeared later, and differentiate between these. Most of those who has written explanations of Quran, define the terminology of the noble Quran as per the meanings which prevailed during the first three centuries after the revelation of Quran. It is essential for researchers to take those meanings into account which prevailed at the time of Quranic revelation.

In this connection it is better to take the help of the Quran and study the words which appear repeatedly, in order to determine their meanings. If one does that, one will find that the same word has been used to express several meanings, for example, the word "**hidayah**". With deliberation, it is possible to determine its meaning at a particular place. That is why it is said that one place of the Quran explains another. Thus in order to determine the particular meaning of a word, it is imperative to see whether it jives with the foregoing text, agrees with the entire text and subject, and is in line with the overall purpose of the Quranic message.

I am a student of the Quran. My entire lifetime, from childhood to the current time, has been an association with this great Book. In the beginning I too studied the Quran in the traditional way, but it made no impact. Later when I gave it a critical review, I realized that the real meaning of the Quran was different one then generally accepted. I was lucky to get some insight of the thoughts of the great poet **Allama Iqbal**, just as when I was struggling with this. From his insights I came to know, among other things, that Quran should be understood in the Arabic language and with the help of explanation of the verses, while external influences should be shunned. To understand the Quranic verses, one had to use "**tabveeb al-Quran**" i.e. compiling all verses regarding one subject at one place. But in respect of "**tabveeb al-Quran**", what was conceptualised by **Allama Iqbal**, and which he related to me in detail, was not found in any book. This needed the compilation of an entirely new book.

I tried my best to induce some groups or individuals to undertake the task so they could do a better job at this task than I ever could, but did not succeed in finding any. Ultimately I had to take the burden of this task on my own shoulders. For this, I compiled verses under several subjects. This took me several years. After classification of the verses on the lines of an encyclopaedia, I compiled every subject into an integrated document.

Thus came into a series of books, such as

- "**Mutaraf-ul-Quran**" (An introduction to Quran).
- "**I and God**"
- "**Iblees and Adam**"
- "**Jooye Noor**"
- "**Burq Toor**"
- "**Shola Mastoor**"
- "**Mairaj Insaniyaat**"

I am working on some other titles as well and they as well be published in due course.

The publication of my book "**Mutar-ul-Quran**" and other writings, and papers, resulted in rekindling the greatness and value of the noble Quran in the hearts of the country's educated, young folk (especially those who had turned away from religion). The main purpose of my toil of years' waste very same i.e. to bring the young folk (who had run away from the self-made religions of man and thus were also running away from Allah's sayings) to come close to the Quran and deliberate directly in it. (With God's help) The result of my humble efforts was beyond my expectations. A large number of young people came closer to the Quran, thank God.

These young people came close to the Quran alright, but when they were told to understand it directly, they complained that no present translation, nor explanation that would help them in understanding the Quran, existed. And they were right in saying so, because they meant that they must be shown the way by

which they could comprehend the Quran directly. This included those who knew the Arabic language and those too who didn't. After deliberating for some time, I arrived at the decision that there should be a dictionary of the noble Quran in which the meanings of the Quranic words and phrases were explained. I tried my best, but could not find any such dictionary. Dictionaries aside, but except some sayings of **Imam Raghīb**, I could not even find any book which could even be called a proper Quranic dictionary.

Recently some books have appeared under the title "**Lughat-ul-Quran**", but they fail to fulfil the mentioned purpose.

Allama Hameeduddin Farahi had tried to organize a dictionary of this sort, and even determined the meaning of some words in this manner. If he had compiled such a dictionary for the entire Quran, then no doubt that it would be a very useful book. According to my consciousness, I have taken the help of his Quranic work. Due to the circumstances, there was no other way but to compile a fresh Quranic dictionary. The difficulty of compiling such a dictionary for the Quranic words and terms on the pattern above can be well understood by scholars. I tried very hard to get together some group, as I had tried before, to do this very difficult and challenging great work. But I failed once again. On one hand this was the situation, and on the other was the demand of those people (whom I had brought closer to the Quran). They were getting more intense as to how to understand the Quran more directly. When I considered myself for the job, I didn't seem to find either the courage or the ability to undertake such important task. This went on for quite some time.

At last, it was decided that no matter what quality, the work should be undertaken. Once the foundation was laid, men with better ability could work on this foundation and produce something better. These were the circumstances under which I decided to compile such a dictionary, and after the toil of many years, this dictionary is before your eyes. During this difficult journey, I also consulted scholars, those who were willing.

I cannot but mention **Mr. Habib Mukarram** (former ambassador of Egypt) and **Dr. Abdul Wahab Uzam** who had great knowledge of the Arabic language and love for the Quran. I was lucky to have known these two gentlemen. I had close relations with them in connection with the translation and meanings of **Allama Iqbal's** poetry. I can't express enough the extent to which I benefited from their knowledge of the Arabic language

After compiling the dictionary, I had it gone over by scholars whose knowledge of the Arabic language and love for the Quran was known to me. I am grateful from the core of my heart to all such friends. But nevertheless, I declare that whatever is contained in this book is solemnly my responsibility. I am sorry that **Allama Aslam Jerajpuri** died before this dictionary was completed. I wish he had lived to go through it. I am indebted grateful to him for the Quranic insight he gave me for my book "**Mafhoum-ul-Quran**".

References

Taj-ul-Uroos {T}

In the compiling and editing of this book, the question was as to which book of Arabic dictionary should be made its fundament. Three dictionaries are very famous, "*Lissan-ul-Arab*", "*Taj-ul-Uroos*" and "*Qamoos*". Some other books are famous as well, and in certain matters enjoy even more importance than the three mentioned here. After studying the benefits and good points of these three, it was decided to choose "*Taj-ul-Uroos*". *Taj-ul-Uroos* explains *Qamoos* and since it was compiled after *Lissan-ul-Arab*, it contains the linguistic details. Thus it can be said that *Taj-ul-Uroos* is the latest, detailed and authentic dictionary which contains the all formerly published authentic dictionaries.

Lissan-ul-Arab is compiled by *Ibn Mukarram*, who died in 711 Hijri.

Qamoos is compiled by *Allama Ferozabadi* who died in 816 Hijri.

Taj-ul-Uroos is compiled by *Mohibuddin Ibnul Faiz Alsayed Muhammad Murtaza Alhuseni Alwasti Alzubedi Alhanafi* who died in 1205 Hijri or 1701 A.D. He edited his renowned dictionary in Egypt. It was published in 10 big volumes. The book we are referring to is published by *Matba'ul Khairia* and the date of publishing written on it is 1306 A.D. (First Edition).

According to *Edward William Lane*, except *Lissan-ul-Arab*, one hundred dictionaries have been consulted in compiling *Taj-ul-Uroos*. In the English language, the Arab dictionary (Lane's Lexicon) is also based on *Taj-ul-Uroos*. As such, this dictionary is very scientific.

Raghib {R}

We referred also to *Imam Raghib Isfahani's* famous book, "*Almafrudaat fi gharibul Quran*" or "The sayings of the Quran".

This is a dictionary of Quranic words and so famous that it needs no introduction. But this book is very brief. The edition we are referring to was printed in Egypt in 1324 A.D.

Ibn Faris {F}

The third important book we refer to is *Ibn Faris'* "*Muqabeesul Lugha*" which details the root of every word and its meaning. Since the central idea of our dictionary is the basic meaning of the root of words, substantial reference has been made from this book of *Ibn Faris'*. The book we are talking about was initially printed in Egypt in the year 1902 A.D in six volumes.

Muheet {M}

After this the book which was consulted most was *Pitra Bostani's* "*Muheet-ul-Muheet*".

It is a brief book (has only two volumes) but it is very beneficial. The book we are referring to was printed in Beirut in 1870 A.D.

These are the books of reference, commonly referred to in this dictionary. Besides these, the following books have been consulted as well

- a) "***Fikah ul lugha***" ***Abu Mansoor's*** brief i book which despite its brevity is thought to be very authentic. Our reference book was printed in 1938 in Egypt.
- b) "***Agrabul Muaarid***" A famous dictionary which was compiled by ***Saeed Alkhouri Alshartuni Allebani***. The book in reference was printed in Beirut in 1889.
- c) "***Muntahil Arab***" A famous Arabic-Persian dictionary. Our reference is to version printed by Islamic Publications, Lahore in 1920.
- d) "***Kitabul Ashtaqaq***" ***Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan's*** brief magazine, but it details the characteristics of the letters of the roots of words very well.
- e) "***Al-fazul Mutaradifa***" ***Ali Ibn Isa Alrumani's*** brief magazine, who died in 384 Hijri and describes the superficial and deep difference between alternate words.
- f) "***Latayeful lugha***" This is a book by ***Ahmed Bin Mustafa Allaba Bedi*** (of Damascus) which discusses the linguistic niceties in detail.
- g) "***Kitabul Qartain***" This is a book based on a book by ***Imam Din Kutaiba Aldeenwari*** who died in 277 Hijri, printed in Egypt in 1355. ***Ibn kutaiba*** enjoys a good reputation among scholars.
- h) "***Al-bustan***" This dictionary is by ***Abdullah Albustani Allebnani*** who died in 1930, printed in 1927. Its foreword is quite good.

Besides the above mentioned dictionaries, reference has also been made to ***Zamkhashwi's tafser (Kashaf)***, ***tafseer Jalaleen*** and ***Allama Muhammad Abdohu's famous Tafseer-al-manar***. Some other books have also been referred to.

This letter is used to symbolize a question, as well as to call out (to someone). The following examples will make this clear:

1. To ask someone a question:

Is Zaid standing?	أَرَيْدُ قَائِمٌ
Is that Zaid standing or <i>Umaro</i> ?	أَرَيْدُ قَائِمٌ أَمْ عَمْرٌ

The answer is likely to be:

Yes / No	لَا / نَعَمْ
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Describing the story of *Ibrahim* (Abraham), the Quran says

21:63	Is it you who have done this to our gods?	بِأَلْهِنَا هَذَا فَعَلْتَ أَأَنْتَ
79:27	Are you more difficult to create or is the sky?	أَأَنْتُمْ أَشَدُّ خَلْقًا أَمْ السَّمَاءُ

2. A question which is followed by a denial to invigorate positivity.

95:8	Isn't Allah the greatest of all rulers?	أَلَيْسَ اللَّهُ بِأَكْبَرَ الْحَاكِمِينَ
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Thereby the meaning here is not to say that Allah is not the greatest of all rulers, but to assert the opposite, that He is in fact exactly that. Here *Hamza* is followed by *lays* for a denial, but the denial does not denote a denial of what is being said - later, but it is indeed its assertion, which is said with force.

3. A question in which a sense of scolding exists.

3:82	Do they prefer some other <i>Deen</i> (way of life) than the <i>deen</i> of Allah?	يَبْغُونَ اللَّهَ دِينَ أَفْغَيْرَ
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The aim of the above is to be sarcastic and ask if they really want such a thing. The indication is that they should not desire it.

4. A question which is tinged with ridicule.

From the story of *Shoaib's* (Jethro of the Bible) nation, they tell the following to him.

11:87	Does your <i>salah</i> ask us to abandon the gods of our forefathers?	أَصَلَاتُكَ تَأْمُرُكَ أَنْ نَتْرَكَ مَا يَعْْبُدُ
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This sentence contains satire, ridicule and even amazement.

5. For expressing amazement

25:45	Haven't you wondered how your Sustainer elongates the shadows?	أَلَمْ تَرَ إِلَى رَبِّكَ كَيْفَ مَدَّ الظَّلَّ
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Here “أَلَمْ تَرَ” (*alam tara*) has been said to portray wonder, but this phrase usually means an invitation to reflect or deliberate. Similar are “أَفَلَا” (*afala*), “أَوَلَا” (*awala*), “أَفَلَمْ” (*afalam*) and “أَوَلَمْ” (*awalam*).

6. To warn if something has been delayed.

57:16	Has the time not come for the Believers to...?	أَلَمْ تَرَ إِلَى رَبِّكَ كَيْفَ مَدَّ الظَّلَّ
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Thereby, the meaning of the above verse is that the time has indeed come.

7. A question which actually is an order.

Like when we say: “will you do this or not?”

The real purpose of such a question is to order someone to actually do this.

Ibrahim's (Abraham) father said to him:

19:46	Do you (dare to) avoid my gods?	أَرَاغِبُ أَنْتَ عَنْ آلِهَتِي
19:46	I'll punish you humiliatingly.	لَأَرْجُمَنَّكَ

The meaning here is that “I order you not to do this, otherwise I will punish you.”

8. To equalize two things, but only when it appears after the word "sawaye"

2:6	Whether you warn them or not, (against the devastating results of their path), is the same (useless).	سَوَاءٌ عَلَيْهِمْ أَأَنذَرْتَهُمْ أَمْ لَمْ تُنذِرْهُمْ
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9. For calling out:

“أَزَيْدُ أَقْبِيلُ” (*azaida aqbil*) would mean: O Zaid, forge ahead! The Quran has not used this format.

10. Alif as a Hamza - ا

Hamza always appears in the beginning of a sentence, “أَوَلَمْ يَنْظُرُوا” (*aolam yanzoro*), “أَفَلَمْ يَسِيرُوا” (*afalam yasiro*)

Sometimes it is even omitted, for instance: before 'whether' “أَمْ” (*am*)

This is the case in the tale of Ibrahim on the night when the moon appeared and he asked his nation:

6:77	He said, is this my Sustainer?	قَالَ هَذَا رَبِّي
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The meaning is off course sarcastic, and means to say; “do you want me to worship it?” Here, the letter alif which is the questioner has been omitted. Some people think that this “هَذَا رَبِّي” (*haza rabbi*) is not said by *Ibrahim* but his father (*Azar*) and the portion following thereafter in the same verse is the answer given by *Ibrahim*.

6:77	Then he said, “this is my Sustainer”, but when it descended, he said “If the Sustainer does not guide me, then I shall become one of the unfair”	فَلَمَّا أَفَلَ قَالَ لَئِنْ لَمْ يَهْدِنِي رَبِّي لَأَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْقَوْمِ الضَّالِّينَ
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In other words, it is a dialogue. If so, then there is no need to consider the *alif* as omitted. Note that when one *hamza* is followed by a word which begins with another *hamza*, then the two *hamzas* together become an *alif* with a *mudda'a*. ا As in اَلْآنَ (what now?). This actually sounds like the beginning with two *alifs* with 'zabar'.

“الْأَبُّ” (*al-abbu*): grass, whether dry or fresh. This word is used for all kinds of grass on which animals graze.

The Quran says:

80:31	And fruits and green grass	وَفَاكِهَةً وَأَبًّا
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Mujahid says that “فَاكِهَةً” (*fakiha*) is fruit eaten by men; and “أَبًّا” (*abba*) are things that animals eat. This includes green grass, fodder, dry grass etc.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of the term is of grazing land, and intent. This is probably because animals go to the grazing land with a definite intent of eating.

Some others maintain that “أَبًّا” (*abba*) for animals is the same as “فَاكِهَةً” (*fakiha*) for Man. In short, it is used for something which is eaten happily. Therefore أَبًّا are those things which animals love to eat.

“الْأَبَدُ” (*al-abad*): ‘unlimited period of time’, or ‘always’. *Ibn Faris* says it means ‘elongated time’.

Raghib says it means ‘a long time which cannot be measured’. Hence it means ‘time that cannot be divided into segments, or be measured’.

Against this we have “زَمَانٌ” (*zaman*) which means measurable time. As such, there should be no feminine gender or plural for this word but even then, it has a plural, which is “أَبَادٌ” (*aabad*). Some say that the word “أَبَادٌ” (*aabad*) is never used by Arab poets.

“الْأَوَابِدُ” (*al-awabid*): ‘wild beasts’, because the Arabs thought that they don’t die their own deaths but die only because of some trouble. “أَوَابِدُ” (*aawabid*) also means ‘trouble’.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that when “ba” is accompanied by *hamza*, it implies hatred, wildness, enmity and separation. “أَبْدَالُ الْوَحْشِ” (*aabdalwahash*) would mean ‘wild animals fled after rearing up’.

The Quran uses “الْأَبَدُ” (*alabad*) in the meaning we usually take i.e. “always”.

2:95	They can never wish for that (<i>jannah</i>)	وَلَنْ يَتَمَنَّوْهُ أَبَدًا
4:169	And they will live there forever	خَالِدِينَ فِيهَا أَبَدًا

“أَبْدِي” (*abdi*) and “أَزْلِي” (*azli*) are not Quranic terms. “أَزْلِي” (*azli*) has not even been mentioned in the Quran. As such, “أَبْدِي” (*abdi*) would mean ‘a long time’. So, while it is a mention of the dwellers of *jahannam*, in 4:169, it is also said that they shall abide there for a very long time. See heading H-Q-B)

This has also been elaborated by:

11:106	till there is the sky and the earth	مَا دَامَتِ السَّمَاوَاتُ وَالْأَرْضُ
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From this it becomes clear that “أَبْدِي” (*abadi*) does not mean a never-ending period. The debate about “*zaman*” as ‘Time’ is very scholastic, deep and technical. That is why we will not enter such a debate here. Here, I only want to say that when we say *abdi* or *azli*, we only attribute these traits to Allah and no one else. Do not take the last part to mean that *jahannam* ends after some period: that *jahannam* will expire after a time and those who dwell in it will go to some other place after being extricated from it.

At several places in the Quran it has been made clear that there is no question of getting out of *jahannam*.

Ibrahim's time comes chronologically after **Nooh**, **Hoodh** and **Saleh**. (For tales about them see relevant headings.)

But, as the founder of the nation of **Ibrahim** and the builder of the **Kaba** (House of Allah), the Quran mentions him in detail. The Holy **Taurah** states that in the eighth generation of **Noah**, **Nahur** was born, whose son was **Azar**, and **Azar's** son was **Ibrahim**. **Azar's** family was settled in a Chaldean city named **Ur**.

At that time, the Chaldean civilization was at its peak. According to a historical estimate, his time can be fixed at 2200 B.C. His nation was engaged in idol and star worship. Ibrahim's father was a great idol-worshipper. He started his call to worship One Allah from his own (father's) home (6:75). The father vehemently opposed it (16:46).

Then **Ibrahim** addressed his people and told them that they were indulging themselves in sin (21:52). This tension rose to such a peak that one day he went to their temple and smashed their idols (21:58). During this, there was also a dialogue between him and the king and he left the king speechless with his arguments and reasoning (2:258).

One after another, their defeats kindled the fires of vengeance in the nation and they were after his blood.

But Allah foiled all their schemes and he (Ibrahim) along with his nephew Loot (Lot) who was also a Messenger, left for Egypt (21:67-68). He settled in Palestine.

He settled his son **Is-haq** (Isaac) in **Falasteen**, and took his other son Ismail along with him. With Allah's blessings they went to a **ghair zi zarah** (uncultivable) valley and built the **Ka'ba** (2:125). He made **Ismail** its administrator.

All messengers of Israelites belonged to the progeny of **Is-haq**, and **Muhammad** was the flower of the dynasty of **Ismail**.

This was **Ibrahim** about whom Allah says:

16:120	Undoubtedly, Ibrahim (in his personae) was not an individual but an entire nation, bowing before Allah, and he was not among the " mushrekeen " (those who believe in more than one God).	إِنَّ إِبْرَاهِيمَ كَانَ أُمَّةً قَانِتًا لِلَّهِ خَنِيفًا وَمَا يَكُ مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ
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A-B-Q

أ ب ق

“أَبَقَ الْعَبْدُ أَبَقًا وَ إِبَاقًا” (**abaqa-la'bda abqa wa ibaq'a**) is the fleeing of a slave (leaving behind his work). Neither he is given very hard work, nor is there any fear, still the slave opts to run away.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan says that when **bah** and **hamza** come together they give the sense of wildness, enmity, hatred, separation etc. Here, too, “أَبَقَ” (**abaq**) imparts the same sense.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of it is running away of a slave, or to perpetrate violence in some matter.

“أَلْأَبَقَ” (**al-abaq**): one who leaves one's duty behind and flees, or one who hides.

“تَتَابَقَ الشَّيْءُ” (**tabbaqashi**) is someone who stays away from something considering it to be unpleasant.

“عَبَدَ أَبَقُ” (**abadan aabiqun**): a slave who has run away.

The Quran has used this expression for **Yunus**:

37:140	When he ran towards the boat that was full	إِذْ أَبَقَ إِلَى الْفُلِّ الْمَشْحُونِ
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A *rasool* (messenger) was sent towards a nation with a particular mission.

He had to suffer hundreds of ignominies and he never left his place under any circumstances. But when Deity feels that it is no longer conducive for the mission for him to stay at a place any longer, it orders him to leave the place and go somewhere else. This is called “*hijra*” (migration).

It seems that when *Yunus* felt that his nation was not ready to give up its insolence towards Allah, he decided, on his own, that the environment was not good for the Message of Allah. Thus he left the place.

His decision came before the time planned according to the Deity’s program, (and he had left his place without Allah’s orders to do so). That is why this act of his was called “*abq*” (*abq*). In other words, he left his duty. It may be noted that he had not flouted any of Allah’s orders. He had simply made a decision on his own. But since this decision was made before the right time, Allah didn’t approve.

This gives an idea as to how much the life of a *rasool* is subservient to Allah’s will, and matters in which the decision is laid in the hands of Allah, the *rasool* could not even take one step on his own. However, he had permission in other matters to decide his line of action according to the rules of *wahi* (Revelation).

A-B-L أ ب ل

“*al-ibil*” and “*al-iblu*” are used for a large number of camels. These words do not have a singular. Clouds also find reference to camels.

The Quran says:

88:17	Do they not see the clouds, as to how they have been created?	أَفَلَا يَنْظُرُونَ إِلَى الْإِبِلِ كَيْفَ خُلِقَتْ
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Here, “*al-iblu*” could also mean “clouds”. “*abilun ababili*”: herd after herd of camels.

105:3	Did He not send flocks and flocks of birds?	وَأَرْسَلَ عَلَيْهِمْ طَيْرًا أَبَابِيلَ
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“*al-ibal*”, “*al-abol*”, “*al-ibil*”, “*al-ibalah*”: bunch of birds, horses and camels which come one after another in waves.
“*abal*”: ‘he was bewildered.’

According to *Ibn Faris*, it has three basic meanings: camel, to be sufficient, load or overwhelming.

A-B-W أ ب و

“*aaba*” is the plural of “*aab*” which in fact was “*abu*” which means “father” or the person who is instrumental in siring another of his species, or a person who is the manifest, or invention of such a person. This word is also used for someone older, such as an uncle. Besides that, due to seniority and age, every elderly person is called “*aabun*”.

“*abaota abwa*”: “his upbringing was done by me”.
“*tabbah*”: “I made him my father”.

In the Quran the word “*aabau*” is used for forefathers.

2:170	what we found our forefathers to be doing	مَا أَفْلَحْنَا عَلَيْهِ آبَاؤُنَا
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This word is also used for uncles and grandfather, as in surah *Al-Baqrah*, when *Yaqoob* [Jacob] asked his sons, “Who will you worship when I am gone?”

2:133	who will you worship when I am gone” and they replied “We will worship your God, and the God of your forefathers Ibrahim, Ismail and <i>Ishaq</i> ”	لَبَنِيهِ مَا تَعْبُدُونَ مِنْ بَعْدِي قَالُوا نَعْبُدُ إِلَهَكَ وَإِلَهَ آبَائِكَ إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْمَاعِيلَ وَإِسْحَاقَ
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Ishaq was *Yaqoob*’s father, *Ismail* was his uncle and Ibrahim was his grandfather. For all of them, the word “آبَاءُ” (*aabau*) has been used.

In surah *Yusuf* we find the word “أَبَوَيْهِ” (*abawaeh*) which means parents (mother and father) 12:99.

When calling out to the father, “يَا أَبَتِ” (*ya abat*) has also been used instead of “يَا أَبِي” (*ya abiy*) as in 12:4 “الْأَبَا” (*al-aba*) is a form of “الْأَبُ” (*al-abu*) and means ‘father’.

A-B-Y أ ب ي

According to *Ibn Faris*, the basic meaning of this root is to dislike something, to abstain from something, abstain, to refuse with vehemence. “أَبَى الشَّيْءَ يَأْبَاهُ” (*abasheia yabah*)

“أَخَذَهُ أَبَاءٌ مِنَ الطَّعَامِ” (*akhazho abao minata’am*): he hated the food.

“رَجُلٌ أَبْيَانٌ” (*rajulun abyān*): one who abstains from food.

“الْإِبَاءُ” (*al-ibao*): hatred, displeasure, pride etc.

In other words, it means to refuse something because of not being up to expected standards.

It also means to do something that one likes, and not allow it to anyone else.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan says that when “*ba*” and “*hamza*” appear together, they convey a sense of wildness, hatred, enmity and separation.

“الْأَبْيَ” (*al-aabiya*) is used for a lion, because he too does what he wants without heeding anybody else.

“أَبِي” (*abiya*) conveys this sense. “أَبَى وَاسْتَكْبَرَ” (*abai wastakbar*) appears against “سَجْدَةً” (*sajdah*)

“genuflection” in 2:34. This means that *Iblees* ignored Allah’s orders and was unfaithful.

2:282	when witnesses are called (to give evidence), they should not refuse, shouldn’t stop (from giving evidence)	وَلَا يَأْبِ الشُّهَدَاءُ إِذَا مَا
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There is another manner in which it has been used in the Quran. Surah *Bani Israel* says that God has stated the Quranic truths in different ways.

17:89	And We have certainly diversified for the people in this Quran from every kind of example, but most of the people refused anything except disbelief.	وَلَقَدْ صَرَّفْنَا لِلنَّاسِ فِي هَٰذَا الْقُرْآنِ مِنْ كُلِّ مَثَلٍ فَأَبَى أَكْثَرُ النَّاسِ إِلَّا كُفُورًا
25:50	And We have certainly distributed it among them that they might be reminded, but most of the people refuse and accept disbelief.	وَلَقَدْ صَرَّفْنَاهُ بَيْنَهُمْ لِيَذَّكَّرُوا فَأَبَى أَكْثَرُ النَّاسِ إِلَّا كُفُورًا

In other words, they abstain from deliberating and hence are unable to find Allah’s path.

Similarly, in surah *At-Tauba*, it is said:

9:32	Allah doesn’t accept anything except to complete his light	وَيَأْتِي اللَّهَ إِلَّا أَنْ يُمِمْ نُورُهُ
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These examples make it clear that with the word “إِلَّا” (*illa*), the words mean that “nothing else, besides this is acceptable”.

In surah *Al-Kahaf*, *Moosa* and his companion's tale have the following:

18:77	the residents (thinking them to be lowly) refused to be their hosts	فَأَبَوْا أَنْ يُضَيِّقُوا
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“آتَي” (*aatai*) or “يَاتَي” (*yatai*): “to come”.

Raghib says, “إِتْيَانٌ” (*ityanun*): to come comfortably.

Muheet has given the example of “آتَي الْمَاءَ” (*atayolama'a*) which means, “made the water’s path easy”.

“مَاتِيًّا” (*matiiyan*): “one who comes definitely”, (as if he has arrived). 19:61

“مَاتِيًّا” (*matiiyan*) is in fact past tense, and it means the object which one approached, or the thing which has already arrived. In this way, it would mean that everything meets the fate ordained by God.

“أَتَى إِلَيْهِ الشَّيْءُ” (*atya ileihishai*): something was sent towards him.

“أَتَى فَلَا نَاشِيًّا” (*atyafulana shyan*): he gave him that thing.

Abu al-Qasim Mahmud ibn Umar al-Zamakhshari writes in his book *Al-Kashaaf* that “آتَى” (*atya*) is often used for “إِعْطَاءٌ” (*i'taun*), but “إِيْتَاءٌ” (*iytaun*) actually means to present someone something. .

That is why the word “إِيْتَاءٌ” (*iytaun*) has been used to describe *sadaqat* (benevolence), in the Quran, according to **Raghib**. Reason for this can be that *sadaqat* may have been given with ease and the need to investigate, as to what had been given by whom, was simply not there.

The compiler of *Taj-ul-Uroos* give the examples of different sayings and maintains that “إِعْطَاءٌ” (*i'taun*) and “إِيْتَاءٌ” (*iytaun*) differ in meanings that because in “إِعْطَاءٌ” (*i'taun*) the giver holds a slightly upper position but in “إِيْتَاءٌ” (*iytaun*) the recipient’s position may be better than the giver, or at least the same.

But we cannot take it as a rule because both words have been used as alternates, as in surah *At-Tauba*. It is said:

9:58	Some of them criticize you regarding the <i>sadqaat</i> . If they are given some of it, then they are pleased, if they do not get of it, they get angry	وَمِنْهُمْ مَّنْ يَلْمُوكَ فِي الصَّدَقَاتِ فَإِنْ أُعْطُوا مِنْهَا رَضُوا وَإِنْ لَمْ يُعْطُوا مِنْهَا إِذَا هُمْ يَسْتَخْطُونَ
9:59	And (how nice it would be) if they were happy with what God and his Messenger had given them.	وَلَوْ أَنَّهُمْ رَضُوا مَا آتَاهُمُ اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ

Regarding booty distribution, it is said in the Quran:

59:7	Whatever is given to you by the Messenger, take it and resist from taking what he forbids.	وَمَا آتَاكُمُ الرَّسُولُ فَخُذُوهُ وَمَا نَهَاكُمْ عَنْهُ فَانْتَهُوا
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This has been further explained in 9:59. This means the principle regarding war booty is not that one gets to keep whatever he collects.

All booty belongs to Allah’s system, and it is disbursed by a central figure. In surah *Aal-e-Imran* this word appears apropos “نَزَعَ” (*naz'a*) which means to take.

3:25	you give power to whom you wish and take away power from whom you wish	الْمُلْكُ مَن تَشَاءُ وَتَنْزِعُ الْمُلْكُ مِمَّن تَشَاءُ
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“أَتَى الرَّجُلُ” (*atayorrajolo*): that he did something, or performed some act.

The Quran says:

20:69	thereby, no matter what a sorcerer does, he can never succeed	وَلَا يُفْلِحُ السَّاحِرُ حَيْثُ أَتَى
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Or, as it appears at another location

26:165	Contrary to universal practice, you perform this act with males".	أَتَاوْنَ الذُّكْرَانَ مِنَ الْعَالَمِينَ
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The writer of *Taj-ul-uroos* says that “إِعْطَاءٌ” (*i'taun*) and “إِيْتَاءٌ” (*iytaun*) also differ in that “إِيْتَاءٌ” (*iytaun*) refers to what is given to somebody does reach him and he also accepts it, whereas “إِعْطَاءٌ” (*i'taun*): that what is given to somebody doesn't necessarily reach him.

The Quran says:

17:20	what has been given by God is common, but God does not take it to every individual	وَهُؤُلَاءِ مِنْ عَطَاءِ رَبِّكَ وَمَا كَانَ رَبُّكَ مَحْطُورًا
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This means that one has to struggle to get it. Nobody has the right to prevent His benevolence from reaching anyone, or act as a barrier to that benevolence.

Taj-ul-uroos also mentions that “إِيْتَانٌ” (*iytanun*) means ‘to kill’.

59:2	Allah annihilated them in a way of which that they hadn't even thought of	فَأَنآهُمُ اللَّهُ مِنْ حَيْثُ لَمْ يَحْتَسِبُوا
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A-Th-Th أ ث ث

“الْأَثَاطُ” (*al-athath*): a large part of something, unbounded wealth, household goods, every kind of goods i.e. camels, goats, slaves, etc. “أَثَاطَةٌ” (*athathah*) is the singular. Some say it is used for all kinds of household goods but not goods for trading.

Ibn Dureed says, “أَثَاطُ الْبَيْتِ” (*athathul-baiti*): “الْمَتَاعُ الْجَيِّدُ” (*al-mata'ol-jayadu*) i.e. precious goods.

Ibn Faris says that it basically means ‘gathering and softness’, as in “أَثَ النَّبْتُ أَثَا” (*athanabtun aatha*) which means that ‘the plants have become lush’.

In the Quran “أَثَاطًا وَمَتَاعًا” (*athathawa mta'a*) appears in meaning of ‘goods’.

A-Th-R أ ث ر

“الْأَثَرُ” (*a-athar*): remaining part of ruins etc. It also means remaining scar after that wound has healed.

“الْأَثِيرَةُ” (*al-athirah*): an animal that leaves tracks behind on the ground it has walked upon.

“الْأَثَرُ نُوْرٌ وَالْمَيْتَرُ” (*al-totharru nooro walmaytharru*): an iron implement which is used to mark the underside of a camel's foot so that the camel can be branded, and can be identified later on, with the help of that mark if it gets lost.

The writer of *Muheet* says that “أَثَرٌ” (*athar*) has four meanings:

- 1) Result of something
- 2) A sign
- 3) News
- 4) An order.

30:50	So notice the signs of Allah's <i>rahmat</i>	فَانْظُرْ إِلَى آثَارِ رَحْمَتِ اللَّهِ
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Here “أَثَرٌ” means symbol, mark or sign.

48:29	Mark on their faces	أَثَرِ السُّجُودِ
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The heartfelt peace and tranquillity is the result of obeying Allah, and gets evident from facial expressions.

Surah *Al-Momin* says:

40:21	They were greater than them to plant tracks in the land	أَشَدَّ مِنْهُمْ قُوَّةً وَأَثَارًا فِي الْأَرْضِ
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In surah *Yasin*, the word “أَثَارُهُمْ” appears with “قَدَّمُوا”

36:12	Whatever they have sent forth and the tracks they have left behind	مَا قَدَّمُوا وَأَثَارَهُمْ
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In surah *Al-Kahaf*, this word appears in the sense of “footsteps”.

18:6	Back on the marks of their footsteps	عَلَى أَثَارِهِمْ
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The same surah states further on:

18:64	retraced their footsteps	فَارْتَدَّ عَلَى أَثَارِهِمَا قَصَصًا
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Surah *Al-Hadeed* says:

57:27	Then We sent other messengers behind them on their footsteps. (following them)	ثُمَّ فَعَيْنَا عَلَى أَثَارِهِمْ مُرْسِلِينَ
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Ibn Faris says that “الْأَثَرُ” (*al-atharu*) basically means to follow someone’s tracks. This applies to both forms i.e. “اَثَرُ” (*athru*) and “اِثْرُ” (*ithru*).

The Quran says:

20:96	I gained a little from this messenger (<i>Moosa</i>) belief.	فَقَبَضْتُ قَبْضَةً مِّنْ أَثَرِ الرَّسُولِ
20:84	they follow my tracks (beliefs)	هُمْ أُولَاءِ عَلَى أَثَرِي
46:4	O symbol of knowledge	أَنَارَةٌ مِّنْ عِلْمٍ

This means scholastic reasoning (that which remains of knowledge).

“اَثَرُ” (*atharu*): to mark something as someone’s own or somebody else’s.

From this comes “اِثْرًا” (*iytharu*) which means to give someone priority over one’s own self. *Ibn Faris* has also endorsed this meaning.

Apropos the earlier meaning, it appears in the Quran

87:16	Instead, you prefer these immediate benefits. (only the benefits of the physical life)	بَلْ تُؤْثِرُونَ الْحَيَاةَ الدُّنْيَا
79:38	And prefer the physical life	وَأَثَرِ الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا

The second meaning appears in surah *Al-Hashr*:

59:9	And they prefer others over themselves	وَيُؤْثِرُونَ عَلَى أَنْفُسِهِمْ
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The Quran says:

12:91	Indeed, God has preferred you over us	لَقَدْ أَتَرَكَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْنَا
20:72	what has come to us, we will not prefer over you	نُؤْثِرَكَ عَلَى مَا جَاءَنَا

“حَدِيثٌ مَثُورٌ” (*hadethun mathorun*): a story that people have been passing on by telling it to one another.

Ibn Faris writes: “الْمَثُورَةُ” (*al-mathorah*): a well which is now buried, but the bucket and rope are still there as a sign of its existence.

“الْأَثْلُ” means a tree that cast shadow, or a tree that has strong roots.

According to *Ibn Faris*, it means the reality of something or to gather things together. In other words, it means to have a strong base. Quran has used the word of “الْأَثْلُ” in the sense of shadow casting tree (34:16).

“الْأَثِمَةُ” (*al-athimah*) is used for a female camel that gets tired and hence walks very slowly.

“الْمَوَاطِثُ” (*al-mowathim*) is used to define a camel that can't go any further because of exhaustion.

Hence the term “الْإِثْمُ” (*ithmun*) basically means

- Exhaustion,
- Sadness,
- Loss of energy,
- Slow tread,
- Weakness.

Ibn Faris says it means “delay” or “to stay behind”.

The Quran uses “الْإِثْمُ” (*ithmun*) and “عُدْوَانٌ” (*a'dwanun*) for ‘crime’. It refers to all acts which cause weakness in man and weaken his will to act and thus render him unable to traverse through life. To see the relevant elaboration of the word, please see the heading Ain-D-W where the difference between these two words has been illustrated. For this, the Quran has given the example of “خَمْرٌ” (*khamrun*) and “مَيْسِرٌ” (*mayasirun*) which means drinking and gambling, respectively. Here it says that though these do have their benefits, their use weakens human body and mind, and the damage caused is far more than their benefits.

2:219	They ask you regarding drinking and gambling; tell them "In them is great sin, and some profit for men; but the sin is greater than the profit."	يَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ الْخَمْرِ وَالْمَيْسِرِ قُلْ فِيهِمَا إِثْمٌ كَبِيرٌ وَمَنَافِعُ لِلنَّاسِ وَإِثْمُهُمَا أَكْبَرُ مِن نَّفْعِهِمَا
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“خَمْرٌ” (*khamrun*) (intoxicating items) are well known for their debilitating effect on the human body; that is why it is said that heavenly wine will not have any “تَأْثِيمٌ” (*tathimun*) - intoxication.

56:25 56:26	No frivolity will they do not hear therein, nor any taint of ill— Only the saying "Peace! Peace."	لَا يَسْمَعُونَ فِيهَا لُعَا وَلَا تَأْثِيمًا إِلَّا قِيْلًا سَلَامًا سَلَامًا
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The word “مَيْسِرٌ” (*mayasirun*) comes from the word “يُسِرُّ” (*yosrun*) meaning “with ease”. Thus “يُسِرُّ” (*yosrun*) is all earning acquired without due effort. How one becomes lethargic and unable to do hard work due to such income is widely known. Those who earn by claiming interest are also called “اِثْمٌ” (*athimun*) 2:276.

Under the heading Ain-D-W, it has been said that “عُدْوَانٌ” (*a'dwanun*) also means such crimes that have a contagious effect. In other words, other people in society are also affected by it. As such, “اِثْمٌ” (*athimun*) would mean such crimes whose effect is confined to the doer. For example, a man takes opium and lies down quietly. It is obvious that his act affects only him and no one else. But the Quran says even that is a crime, because the purpose of life is to grow and develop. As such, anything which causes weakness is a crime, even if it is self-induced. According to the Quran, it is also a crime to hurt oneself deliberately. Suicide is also murder (of self) and hence falls in the category of “اِثْمٌ” (*athimun*).

Fornication needs no proof to be seen as a crime.

That is why it has been said for illegal/forbidden murder and fornication:

25:68	And the one, who does that, gets rewarded as a sinner.	وَمَنْ يَفْعَلْ ذَلِكَ يَلْقَ أَثَامًا
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Similarly, if someone acquires wealth without working hard (no matter how he gets it) and he doesn't even hurt anybody in doing so, even then it is "اِثْمٌ" (*athimun*) (a crime) because by not working, his faculties will be weakened and according to the Quran, that, too, is a crime.

These, then, are the basic meanings of "اِثْمٌ" (*athimun*).

With the passage of time, people also started to use this word to describe ordinary crime. Some say that it means such act which takes time in producing a result. This, too, is included in its basic meanings, like slowness, delaying in producing result, producing result slowly, like the use of drugs.

Raghib says that "اِثْمٌ" (*athimun*) and "ذَنْبٌ" (*zanab*) differ because "ذَنْبٌ" (*zanab*) can occur unwittingly as well as deliberately but "اِثْمٌ" (*athimun*) is only with intent. But the definition of "بُطْرٌ" (*buto'an*) i.e. to take time is always included in its connotation.

In respect of "اِثْمٌ" (*athimun*), also see the heading (**B-R-R**), because it has also appeared against it as in

5:2	Co-operate with each other in works of <i>birr</i> and <i>taqwa</i> and do not co-operate (in acts of) <i>ism</i> and <i>udwan</i> .	وَتَعَاوَنُوا عَلَى الْبِرِّ وَالتَّقْوَىٰ وَلَا تَعَاوَنُوا عَلَى الْإِثْمِ وَالْعُدْوَانِ
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A-J-J

أ ج ج

"اَلْأَجَّةُ" (*al-ajjah*) and "اَلْأَجِجُ" (*al-ajiju*): 'flare up, to be angered'. It also means the sound of burning fire. "اَجَّ" (*ajja*), "يَوْجٌ" (*yawaja*), "أَجَا" (*ajja*): 'he walked fast'. "سَمِعْتُ أَجَّتَهُمْ" (*sami'tu ajjatahum*) would mean "I heard them walking" or "a mixed sound".

Ibn Faris says that its basic meanings are 'hear sounds' and 'intensity'.

"اَلْأَجَّةُ" (*a-ajjah*): unease, intense heat.

"مَاءٌ أَجَاجٌ" (*ma un ajajun*): very bitter water.

"وَهَذَا مِلْعَ أَجَاجٍ" (*wa haaza mil'a ajaajun*): this water is very brackish (25:53, 35:12).

"أَجَاجٌ فَلَانٌ" (*ajaaja flanun*): he attacked the enemy.

"سَمِعْتُ أَجَّةَ الْقَوْمِ" (*sami'ta-ajjattal qaum*): I heard mixed sound of movements and people's voices.

The words "يَاجُوجُ" (*yajuj*) and "مَاجُوجُ" (*majuj*) appear (Gog and Magog) twice in the Quran: (18:94) and in (21:96).

The former is in respect of King **Zulqarnain** whom the people of a nation pleaded to build a wall so that **Yajuj** and **Majuj** could not come and devastate their abodes. So **Zulqarnain** built them such a wall which surah **Al-Kahaf** mentions in 18:96.

The latter is in reference to surah **Anbia** in which it is said:

21:95	There is a ban on a city which we have destroyed. They shall not return....	وَحَرَامٌ عَلَىٰ قَرْيَةٍ أَهْلَكْنَاهَا أَنَّهُمْ لَا يَرْجِعُونَ
21:96	... until it is open for Yajuj and Majooj , and they stream down from all heights.	حَتَّىٰ إِذَا فُتِحَتْ يَأْجُوجُ وَمَأْجُوجُ وَهُمْ مِّن كُلِّ حَدَبٍ يَنْسِلُونَ

Yajuj and **Majuj** are also mentioned in the Torah and they are also mentioned in the prediction about the Messenger **Hazqeel** (Ezekiel).

(It may be remembered that Nebuchadnezzar had taken messenger **Hazqeel** to Babylon after destroying **Bait-ul-Muqaddas** (The Temple of Solomon) where he was alive till the time of the Persian king Cyrus who is called **Dhulqarnain** in the Quran.)

To the Europeans, **Yajuj** and **Majuj** are known as Gog and Magog. These are said to be Greek names and entered other European languages from there. As to which nations these are, researchers differ. But a majority of them seem to think that these were the desert-dwelling wild tribes of Mongolia who used to loot others. They used to appear like a wild storm and destroy everything before them. Genghis Khan and Helga Khan's warrior tribes are well known.

Mongolia's ancient name is "**Mog**" which turned to **Megog** in Greek and **Majuj** in the Israeli language.

Another tribe of this area was "**Yuachi**" which turned to **Yajuj** in the Israeli language. To avoid their attacks, nations used to build walls around them. These were the plateaus from which these tribes used to come and plunder the nations around them.

Although in surah **Al-Anbia** the names of **Yajuj** and **Majuj** are mentioned, they are meant to signify the plunderers and devastating traits of these tribes, no matter which nation they belong to.

The Quran has said that a nation which falls into ignominy shall not rise again. The only exception is in cases where conquering nation reach an under-developed nation, whose nationalism will be aroused and they will come alive again. But this does not mean that God wishes nations to subjugate nations so that the weaker nations undergo renaissance. Instead the Quran teaches that strong nations must help remove the weaknesses of the weaker nations so that they too can come up. The Quran says that if stronger nations do not do this, then the weaker nations will one day rise and throw away the yoke of slavery or subjugation.

Our era is witness to the fact as to how European nations reached weaker nations (especially Muslim countries) to exploit them, but gradually the weak nations rose against them and thus became lively once again. As such, the devastation of the tribes of **Yajuj** and **Majuj** became the harbinger of a new life for the weak nations and the fact described in (21:95-96) became evident.

Even if we take **Yajuj** and **Majuj** to be particular to their area, then it can also mean to point the fact that the current Russian designs to rule the world could be the reason for the rise of Muslim countries. But this can only happen if the Muslim nations adopt Quranic economic system.

Note: In the above mentioned verse of surah **Al-Anbia** 21:95 and 96, **hatta** has been translated to "up to here", but at other places it has also been used to start a speech and has no meaning. See the word **hatta**.

A-J-R أ ج ر

Ibn Faris says that this word means 'to pay' or repairing fractured bones. A labourer's pay is also called "**أجر**" (**ajar**) because it helps him heal the wounds of labouring. The bones that are stretched in labour are healed by the justified pay.

"**الأجر**" (**al-ajar**) is the justified compensation of someone's work.

"**الأجرة**" (**al-ajrah**) is the justified salary that one receives as compensation for his work.

"**إستيجار**" (**istijarun**) is to employ someone for a salary.

It is said in surah **Qasas**

28:26	O father, employ him for a salary.	يَا أَبَتِ اسْتَأْجِرْهُ
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"**أجر**" (**ajar**) or "**كنية**" (**knayah**) is used for such a gift which a husband gives to his wife on the wedding night. This is generally called "**Mehar**".

The Quran says:

33:50	Those whom you have given wedding presents to	آتَيْتَ أَجُورَهُنَّ
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The Quran has given a firm principal: whatever a man gets (in this life and the hereafter) is the compensation of his own work or actions. Those who don't work don't get paid. This world is a place of work, which has no place for teetotallers. Societies in which people get something without working (except not being able to work) are not formulated according to Quranic laws.

A-J-L

أ ج ل

- “الْأَجَلُ” (*al-ajal*): the fixed time period for something
 “التَّأْجِيلُ” (*at-tajitil*): To fix a time period for something.
 “مُؤَجَّلٌ” (*muwajjal*): The one for whom a time period has been fixed
 “تَأَجَّلَ” (*ta-ajjal*): he delayed.
 “أَجَلٌ” (*ajila*), “أَجَلًا” (*ajjala*): He was delayed.
 “الْأَجَلُ” (*al-ajjal*): the opposite of “عَاجِلٌ”. See heading (*Ain-J-L*)
 “أَجَلٌ” (*ajl*): reason of, because of, due to.
 “أَجَلٌ” (*ajl*) means a fixed period and also the limit where that period ends.

The Quran says

5:32	Due to that reason	مِنْ أَجْلِ ذَلِكَ
7:34	Every nation has a fixed period (for rise and progress).	وَلِكُلِّ أُمَّةٍ أَجَلٌ

But this “أَجَلٌ” (*ajal*) or fixed time is determined according to a law.

13:38	For every fixed period, there is a law	لِكُلِّ أَجَلٍ كِتَابٌ
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And that law is

13:17	Any nation will live as long as it is beneficial to mankind.	مَا يَنْفَعُ النَّاسَ فَيَمْكُثُ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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The Quran has given a detailed program for the rise and fall of nations. This means that the rise and fall of nations is not co-incidental. It happens according to an established principle. The Quran says that the result of any act starts formulating with the beginning but it appears as a tangible result only after a fixed period. The time between an act and its result is also called “أَجَلٌ” (*ajal*). This can also be called “Period of grace”. This grace period too is fixed according to God's laws like the time between a seed becoming a tree.

About death, the Quran says in surah *Aal-e-Imran* that its time period is also fixed according to a law and it is the very same law that fixes its period.

3:145	No living creature dies but in accordance to God's law (i.e. death comes as the law of nature)	وَمَا كَانَ لِنَفْسٍ أَنْ مُتَّ وَلاَ يُبَادِنَ اللَّهُ كِتَابًا مُؤَجَّلًا
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This very law determines the period of a man's life; by abusing one's health, one's age is decreased and by healthy living and avoiding hazardous living, life can be prolonged.

35:11	No man is given a long(er) life nor is anybody's age decreased, but all this happens according to a law.	وَمَا يُعَمَّرُ مِنْ مُعَمَّرٍ وَلاَ يُنْقَصُ مِنْ عُمُرِهِ إِلاَّ فِي كِتَابٍ
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In other words, the extension or decreasing of age is all according to the laws created by God.

A woman's period of *idda* (the waiting period) i.e. isolation after her husband's death, is also called “أَجَلٌ” (*ajal*)

2:221	When you divorce the women and they reach their (<i>idda</i>) period.	وَإِذَا طَلَّقْتُمُ النِّسَاءَ فَبَلَّغُنَّ أَجَلَهُنَّ
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“أَلَاخَذُ” (*al-ahadu*): one, the first number.

“أَحَدٌ” (*ahad*): any one. The feminine is “إِحْدَى” (*ihdi*).

“أَلَاخَذُ” (*al-ahadu*): one of God’s attributes, and has not been used for anyone else in this connotation.

For the difference between “أَحَدٌ” (*ahad*) and “وَاحِدٌ” (*wahad*) see heading W-H-D.

“أَحَدٌ” (*ahad*) has the uniqueness of being the only one.

Therefore it is said “أَحَدُ الْأَحْدَيْنِ” (*ahadul ahadain*) which means “He has no parallel or similar”. This can be the most gracious praise for somebody.

“اتَّحَدَ” (*ittahud*): to gather

“اتَّحَادٌ” (*ithad*): come together and agree upon something.

“اِسْتَأْخَذَ” (*istahad*): individual and alone.

The Quran says:

2:102	but they did not teach anyone	وَمَا يُعَلِّمَانِ مِنْ أَحَدٍ
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“أَلَاخَذُ” (*al-ikhaz*) is the opposite of ‘to bestow’ or ‘to give’; it means ‘to take’; to surround something.

Some say that “أَخَذَ” (*akahz*) also encompasses the sense of anger and overwhelming. This word is used to mean annihilate or uproot, and also punishment as in “مُؤَاخَذَةٌ” (*moakhazah*).

Ibn Faris says that it means “to surround”, “to receive” and “to gather”.

With reference to *Ibn Faris*, *Abu Ubaida* says, that:

“الْأَخَاذُ” (*al-akhaz*): a pool-like place where water gets collected.

“الْأَخِيزُ” (*al-akhiz*): a prisoner.

“الْأَخِيزَةُ” (*al-akhizah*): something which is usurped.

In the Quran, this word has been used in different meanings. In surah *Aal-e-Imran* it is said:

3:80	Do you accept and take as binding on you this My Covenant?	وَأَخَذْتُمْ عَلَىٰ ذَٰلِكُمْ إِصْرِي
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In surah *Yusuf*, it has been used to mean to arrest or to prevent

12:78	Then arrest one of us in his place	فَخَذُوا أَحَدَنَا مَكَانَهُ
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In surah *Hood*, it is used in the sense of the result or return which one gets for his act as per the laws of Nature

11:102	And in this way does God hold (makes them pay) those dwellers which are <i>zalim</i> (unjust). Verily, his hold is woe begetting and very severe.	وَكَذَٰلِكَ أَخَذَ رَبُّكَ إِذَا أَخَذَ الْقُرَىٰ وَهِيَ ظَالِمَةٌ إِنَّ أَخَذَهُ أَلِيمٌ شَدِيدٌ
40:5	And thereafter each nation plotted against their messenger to seize him	وَهَمَّتْ كُلُّ أُمَّةٍ بِرَسُولِهِمْ لِيَأْخُذُوهُ

Here “أَخَذَ” (*akhza*): every type of opposition, in order to stop the Messenger’s mission from progressing.

The Quran says:

8:68	What you did or took	فِيمَا أَخَذْتُمْ
18:86	Be kind to them in behaviour	تَتَّخِذْ فِيهِمْ حَسَنًا

“أَخِرُّ” (*aakhir*) is the opposite of “أَوَّلُ” (*awwal*). The meaning of this word is of being last.

57:3	The one who is the first and the last	هُوَ الْأَوَّلُ وَالْآخِرُ
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The author of *Muheet* says that it means ‘something which follows something else, but does not get followed by anything’. This shows that “أَخِرُّ” (*akhirun*) is the end of a chain, where there is no other link after it.

That is why the Quran has equated this life with a second life as “خَلَقَ جَدِيدٌ” (*khalaqun jadeedun*) (17:49:98 and 42:10). This means that the Afterlife will come as a continuation of and as such, the last link of, this life. But it will come at the natural end of this life and a new life will begin. In this way, it will be the first link to a new life.

Likewise, when after the Quranic revolution, a new civilization begins, which is although linked to the former life, is the last link to that life. This makes a new kind of human civilization. Therefore “أَخِرَّةٌ” (*aakhirah*) is the last segment of any sequence, after which a new sequence begins.

“أَخِرَّةُ الرَّحْلِ” (*aakhiraturrahli*) is used for the back part of a howdah, and is the opposite of “قَادِمَةُ الرَّحْلِ” (*qadimaturrahli*)
 “أَخِرَةُ الْعَيْنِ” (*aakhiratula'een*) is that corner of the eye which is adjacent to the cheek, and “قَادِمَةُ الْعَيْنِ” (*qadimatula'een*) is that part of the eye which is adjacent to the nose.

“أُخِرُّ” (*okhr*) is the opposite of “قُدَّمَ” (*qadamun*), which means to be in front. Therefore, “أَخِرُّ” (*akhir*) means to be behind.

“تَأَخَّرَ” (*takhar*) is the opposite of “تَقَدَّمَ” (*taqaddam*). The meanings of “مُتَقَدِّمٌ” (*motaqadim*) and “مُتَأَخِّرٌ” (*mutakhir*) can be gauged from this.

In the Quran, “يَسْتَأْخِرُونَ” (*yastakhiruna*) appears opposite to “مَاتَسْبِقُ” (*ma tasbiq*) in 18:5, and “مُسْتَأَخِرِينَ” (*mustakhirina*) appears against “مُسْتَقْدِينَ” (*mustaqdinu*) in 17:24.

“أَخَرُ” (*akhar*): outsider or different from others. In this fashion “رَجُلٌ أَخَرٌ” (*rajulun akharun*) would mean, another man. If six men are standing in a queue, then the man opposite to the first man will be “أَخَرُ” (*akhar*). And after the second, the third will be “أَخَرُ” (*akhar*). This process will continue till the last.

After this, it became normal to use the word “أَخَرُ” (*aakharu*) to mean “being different from the last link”.

In surah *Al-Mominoon*, this has been explicitly defined. Regarding human birth, it has been said that it began with essence of the earth, and then the sperm was formulated. Then the sperm turned into a lump of flesh, then the bones were formed, then the bones were covered with flesh; these are the different stages which take place according to the laws of birth, not one link in this chain comes into being without the former link (in other words, no link can be omitted).
 (Up to this stage, animal and human foetuses are still with no differences between them).

Later, it is said:

23:14	And We then raised Man as a new creation	ثُمَّ أَنْشَأْنَاهُ خَلْقًا آخَرَ
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This means that this link in the creative chain is totally different.

This point is towards the human personae, which is not subservient to the physical laws of Nature. This is known as "emergent evolution", i.e. the existence of a new species with is totally different from all former links that it follows during the process of evolution.

Therefore, the concept that comes fore is of human life which (at this stage) is transformed into a creation totally different from its former links. This will continue till his biological death. The death symbolizes the last link of the sequence of life. Life will then start a new sequence in a totally different and new style.

Those who think about our “physical laws” being applicable to that life can’t believe in that life. But those who have eyes and ears, i.e. those who are observant and think, and those who have their eyes on the sudden creative revolutions of nature, can’t do anything else but believe in a life hereafter.

“آخِرَةُ” (*aakhirah*) is that future, which comes as a product of revolution and not according to ordinary circumstances, and that revolution takes place (in its life) through the Quran, and life after death also comes into being due to a revolution.

As against “الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا” (*alhayatid-dunya*) - the life of this world, the Quran uses words like “الْقِيَامَةِ” (*al-qyamah*) and “آخِرَ” (*aakhirah*).

For instance:

2:85	Embarrassment in this life, and harsher punishment in period of the last one.	خِزْيٌ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا وَيَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ يُرْذَوْنَ
2:86	These are the ones who have traded this life, in exchange for that last one.	أُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ اشْتَرُوا الْحَيَاةَ الدُّنْيَا بِالْآخِرَةِ

“الدُّنْيَا” (*ad-dunya*): that which is nearby, and is therefore against “آخِرَ” (*aakhir*) which is that comes quickly. The Quran uses “آخِرَ” (*aakhir*) - that which comes later in 17:18-19 and 75:20-21. Similarly, “تَعْجَلُ” (*ta’ajjalu*) and “تَأَخَّرَ” (*ta-akhara*) have been used as opposites, as in 2:203. “آخِرَةُ” (*aakhirah*) has also been used against “أُولَى” (*aolay*) in other words, e.g. the afterword against this world, as in 79:25.

As stated above, in surah *Al-Hijr* “مُسْتَأْخِرِينَ” (*mustakhirina*) has been used as against “مُسْتَقْدِينَ” (*mustaqdina*) 15:24, meaning those who came later and those who departed earlier, respectively

This has been further expounded as

15:5	No one among peoples can escape the time limit or postpone it.	مَا تَسْبِقُ مِنْ أُمَّةٍ أَجَلَهَا وَمَا يَسْتَأْخِرُونَ
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In surah *Al-Shora*, “فِي الْآخِرِينَ” (*fil aakhirina*) means “those generations that come later” (26:84). As such, the word “آخِرَةُ” (*aakhirah*) includes the concepts of all the happiness in the hereafter, future generations (of man) as against the present humanity, a new life beginning after a revolution, and a new life after this life.

“تَأَخَّرَ” (*akhara*) or “يُؤَخِّرُ” (*yowakhiru*): ‘to do something later, to delay, postpone, and give it time’. “تَأَخَّرَ” (*ta-akhara*): to stay behind or come after another.

2:204	And who hurries in a couple of days (and goes away)....and he who stays behind	فَمَنْ تَعَجَّلَ فِي يَوْمَيْنِ فَلَا إِثْمَ عَلَيْهِ وَمَنْ تَأَخَّرَ
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The Quran says that the *Momineen* (Believers) believe in “آخِرَةُ” (*aakhirah*) which is ‘the future’. They never care for the present (quick) benefits but stay focused on the future.

The grower who grinds wheat seeds meant to be used in the future for sowing, in order to make bread for instant use, gets to eat it instantly, but faces a future of hunger. Contrary to that, the farmer who sows seeds and waits a few months with great patience for the crop to be ready brightens up his future. When this becomes a repeated cycle, then his present becomes bright too. This is because of believing in “آخِرَةُ” (*aakhirah*-future) and for not jumping at the immediate benefits.

Reflect for a while and you will come to the conclusion that only those nations which have the betterment of the future in mind, prosper in this world. A believer is one who believes in the future. But today, under

the sky, the believers (the Muslims) are probably the most negligent of the future and thus lag behind most nations although their future was supposed to be so bright that, even in the hereafter, they were supposed to be ahead of everybody. In the life of an individual, every next breath is the future. For a nation, its future is its coming generation. For human kind, the generation to follow is the future, and for all of them, the life after this biological life is the future. Give it a thought as to what the Quran means when it advises to keep the afterlife in mind as compared to the immediate benefits of the present life (biological life).

Therefore, every individual, or a nation, should:

- 1) Not think only of the present, but also keep the future in mind.
- 2) Not only focus on the welfare of the present generations but also keep an eye on the well-being of the next generations.
- 3) Not consider this biological life as the only life, but have faith in life after death as well.

Also see heading (**D-N-W**).

A-Kh-W أ خ و

The word of “الْأَخُ” (**al-akhu**) has been derived from “أَخِيَّةٌ” (**akhiyah**) which means burying both ends of a rope or steel wire in the ground; thus the loop formed by the rope or wire remaining above the ground was used to tie animals to. As such, “أَخُ” (**akhu**): to be tied to a loop or stake.

This term is used for ‘brother’, or for people who have a common bond of tribalism, religion, trait, love, or some other common issue. Some think that this word has come from “وَحَى” (**wakhi**) which means “intent” and hence this way “أَخُ” (**akhu**) would mean “common intent”. The feminine of the word is “أُخْتُ” (**ukhtu**).

The Quran has used “إِخْوَانٌ” (**ikhwanun**) against “أَعْدَاءُ” (**a'daun**). Such as:

3:103	Once you were each other's enemies, then with His benevolence, He turned you into each other's brothers	إِذْ كُنْتُمْ أَعْدَاءُ فَأَلَّفَ بَيْنَ قُلُوبِكُمْ فَأَصْبَحْتُمْ بِنِعْمَتِهِ إِخْوَانًا
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“أَعْدَاءُ” (**a'ada**): those who have a wedge in-between. Therefore “إِخْوَانٌ” (**ikhwan**) are those who have nothing (no barrier) in between.

As such, “**momineen**” are those people whose hearts are joined like one cloud is joined to another. Quran says that all Momineen are each other's “إِخْوَةٌ” (**ikhwah**).

49:10	Verily all Momineen are each other's peers.	إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ إِخْوَةٌ
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And they all are tied together with the rope of the Quran.

3:102	All of you must hold God's rope strongly	وَأَعْتَصِمُوا بِحَبْلِ اللَّهِ جَمِيعًا
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That is the correct relation between the **Momineen**.

The Quran also uses this word for persons of the same tribe.

27:45	Towards Thamod , we sent their brother, Saleh	وَلَقَدْ أَرْسَلْنَا إِلَى ثَمُودَ أَخَاهُمْ صَالِحًا
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And also for those of the same faith:

17:27	Wasters are the brothers of Shaitan .	إِنَّ الْمُبَذِّرِينَ كَانُوا إِخْوَانَ الشَّيَاطِينِ
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Similarly, “أُخْتُ” (**ukhtu**) has been used for women of the same tribe. **Maryam** has been called **Haroon's** sister.

19:28	O Haroon's sister, your father was no bad man.	يَا أُخْتُ هَارُونَ مَا كَانَ أَبُوكَ امْرَأَ سَوْءٍ
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And, also nations of the same faith have been called each other's “أُخْتٌ” (*akhtu*).

“الْإِدَّةُ” (*al-idda*): wonder, disturbing issue, surprise. “الْإِدِيدُ” (*al-ideedun*): shouting, and the sound of falling water. Meaning thereby, such talk which people dislike so much that an opposition is created and which makes people talk {R}.

“أَدَّ الْبَعِيرُ” (*adda-al-ba'yru*): murmuring of a camel.
 “أَدَّتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*addatin-naqah*): sighing by a female camel, and to cry out loud;
 “أَدَّثَهُ الدَّاهِيَةُ” (*addathud-dahiyah*): he got worried due to a problem.
 “تَدَدَّ دَأُ الْأَمْرِ” (*tadda daa al-amru*) the matter got complicated.

The Quran tells the Christians that by believing that Christ was God's son, they have complicated the matter.

19:89	Indeed, you come up with a very sad and painful statement.	لَقَدْ جِئْتُمْ شَيْئًا إِدًّا
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In other words, they have invented a very dangerous and fictitious belief.

According to *Ibn Faris*, the basic meaning of this root is of becoming very big, grand, in repeated manner; something to get grand and get out of control.

Idrees

إِدْرِيسُ

The Quran has mentioned *Idrees* as one of the Messengers.

19:56	And mention <i>Idrees</i> in the Book, verily he was a true Messenger	وَأَذْكُرْ فِي الْكِتَابِ إِدْرِيسَ إِنَّهُ كَانَ صِدِّيقًا نَبِيًّا
21:85	And <i>Ismael</i> , <i>Idris</i> and <i>Dhul Kifl</i> , they were all steadfast,	وَإِسْمَاعِيلَ وَإِدْرِيسَ وَذَا الْكِفْلِ كُلٌّ مِّنَ الصَّابِرِينَ

But his detailed account does not appear anywhere. It is guessed that his time was even earlier than *Nooh's*. In the *Torah* he has been named as *Hanuk* or *Akhnuh*. If he is indeed *Hanuk*, then he falls into the 4th generation of *Nooh's* forefathers. The *Torah* mentions his genealogical tree as following: *Nooh*, Son of *Lamuk*, Son of *Methuselah*, and Son of *Hanuk* {the book of Genesis 5:21-29}.

A-D-M

أ د م

Ibn Faris says that it means, love, harmony, compatibility.

“أَدَمَةُ” (*admato*): closeness, in agreement, to live together, or inter mingling.
 “أَدَمَةُ” or “أَدَمَةُ” (*adamto or admato*): to mix together, to be in agreement, to love each other.
 “أَدَمَ اللَّهُ بَيْنَهُمْ يَأْدَمُ” means that Allah created mutual harmony among them.
 “الْإِدَامُ” (*al-idamo*) is anything that agrees (with), or which can co-exist.

In reality it means something which is eaten, or goes together, with bread i.e. curry, vegetables etc.

“الْأَدَمَةُ” (*aladma*): wheat. It also means the inside of the skin.
 “إِدَامُ” (*idam*) is such a person by whom one can recognize his tribe.
 “أَادَامِي” (*aadami*) the one associated with “أَدَمُ” (*adama*) which is “human”.

We generally think that Adam (who was expelled from Heaven) was a Messenger (2:3). The Quran does not support this assumption. From the various places in which the Quran mentions his tale, it appears that he was not a particular person but a symbol of the human race. In other words, the tale of Adam is not about a particular pair, but the tale of humans themselves, which the Quran has presented in an allegory.

The tale begins during the time when Man began to live a social life after shunning individualistic life. The word "أدَمَة" (*admatu*) itself points to that social life. Thus "humanism" indicates that condition of human life when humans began to live (together) in society. Living together led to a conflict of interests.

The solution to this conflict was beyond the grasp of human intellect. The solution was given through revelation. Details can be seen in my book *Iblees aur Aadam*.

Even so, there is one place in the Quran where Adam is mentioned as if it was an individual.

3:33	Verily Allah had given priority to Adam and Nooh and the progenies of Ibrahim and Imran (over other nations during their time).	إِنَّ اللَّهَ اصْطَفَىٰ آدَمَ وَنُوحًا وَآلَ إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَآلَ عِمْرَانَ عَلَى الْعَالَمِينَ
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Here **Adam** is mentioned with **Nooh** that makes one think that this is an individual and he (like **Nooh**) was also a messenger although *istefa* has also been used for non-messengers in the Quran. Maybe Adam is the name of some personality towards which this name has been linked in this tale of the Quran, or somebody had been called by this name during this era. I have not called him a Messenger because the Quran has not mentioned him in respect of Messengers.

See 3:41 regarding **Maryam**. Also see 35:32 regarding the followers of the Messenger **Mohammad**. However, Adam mentioned in verse number 3:33 is different from the Adam "who was expelled from Heaven". Maybe he was a messenger (and his name could be Adam), but the Quran has not elaborated further. The tales of messengers generally begin with reference to **Nooh**.

Surah **An-Nisa** says:

4:163	Verily we have sent wahi (Revelation) towards you as we did towards Nooh and the messenger after him.	إِنَّا أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْكَ كَمَا أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَىٰ نُوحٍ وَالنَّبِيِّينَ مِنْ بَعْدِهِ
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However, the Quran also indicates that there had been other Messengers in his nation before him. See 25:37.

The reason for mentioning the tale about Adam in the Quran is to tell man what he would face if he followed any path except shown in the revelation and to tell him that the only way to get back towards a heavenly life is to adhere to Allah's ways. But at the same time it has refuted through this tale the false belief that the Christians had propagated that every child is born a sinner and he comes burdened with the sins of the first parents, and these sins cannot be washed away without having faith on the atonement of Jesus, or that a woman is the fountainhead of all evil because she induced Adam to sin, or to refute the belief as the Hindus propagate that the forces of nature are gods, and man should worship them etc. Through this tale all false beliefs have been refuted.

“أَدَاؤُكَ تَفْعَلُ كَذَا” (*adauta taf'al kaza*) - ‘you kept on planning this’. Its root is “أَدَاةٌ” (*ada*) which means a way or scheme by which one can be reached.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is ‘to take something to someone’, or ‘for a thing to reach something else on its own’.

“أَدَاةً” (*addahu*) or “تَأْدِيَةً” (*ta-adih*): ‘to take to him’.
 “أَدَى دَيْنَهُ” (*addi dinahu*) he paid.

The Quran says:

2:178	and pay (back) debt with nicety	وَأَدَاءِ إِلَيْهِ بِإِحْسَانٍ
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It also means ‘to hand something over to someone’. **Moosa** told Pharaoh: “*aduwa ila-un ibadallah*” (‘hand over the slaves of God to me’).

It is also used for handing back “*amana*” (that which is kept in trust for safe keeping).

2:283	He who has been trusted (with something) must give back the <i>amana</i> (that which has been given in trust for safe keeping).	فَلْيُؤَدِّ الَّذِي اؤْتُمِنَ اَمَانَتَهُ
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أ ذ Idh

“إِذْ” (*iz*) is used for when, at the time, at the place. It is usually used in the past tense.

2:30	When your Sustainer told the <i>Malaika</i> ...	وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلَايِكَةِ
2:127	when Ibrahim was raising the foundations	وَإِذْ يَرْفَعُ إِبْرَاهِيمُ الْقَوَاعِدَ

Sometimes the word means, “Therefore” or “because”. For instance,

43:39	Today it will not be of any use because you used to transgress.	يَنْفَعُكُمُ الْيَوْمَ إِذْ ظَلَمْتُمْ
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With reference to **Suhahi** (another linguist), **William Lane** says that sometimes “إِذْ” (*iz*) is redundant, like:

2:51	It is a fact that We ordered Musa for forty nights	وَإِذْ وَاَعَدْنَا مُوسَى اَرْبَعِينَ لَيْلَةً
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At these places, “إِذْ” (*iz*) creates a new topic.

99:4	that day it will relate all its news	يَوْمَئِذٍ تُحَدِّثُ أَخْبَارَهَا
56:84	and at that time you were watching	وَأَنْتُمْ حِينَالِئِذٍ تَنْظُرُونَ

“إِذَا” (*iza*): different things, for instance:

- 1) Sometimes it is used to mean “suddenly”. In other words it is used when something happens suddenly.

“خَرَجْتُ فَإِذَا أَلَسْدُ بِالْبَابِ” (*kharajtu fa iza alasad bilbaab*): when I came out I saw a lion in front of the door.

20:21	Suddenly he saw that it was a snake and it was moving.	فَإِذَا هِيَ حَيَّةٌ تَسْعَى
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- 2) Sometimes “إِذَا” also means “so” or “thus”. In other words, the result of something,

30:36	And they are visited by woe that is of their own doing, and then they lose hope.	وَإِنْ تُصِيبْهُمْ سَيِّئَةٌ مِمَّا قَدَّمَتْ أَيْدِيهِمْ إِذَا هُمْ يَقْنَطُونَ
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- 3) Sometimes it means “when” in a conditional mode and is used both in the past and future tense,

110:1	When God’s help arrived	إِذَا جَاءَ نَصْرُ اللَّهِ وَالْفَتْحُ
3:159	When you decide firmly then have full faith in God’s law.	فَإِذَا عَزَمْتَ فَتَوَكَّلْ عَلَى اللَّهِ

“إِذَا” (*iza*) is also used when we say: ‘if this happens, then this will be like this or this.’

Surah *Al-Mominoon* says:

23:34	If you follow one like you (then be warned) in that case you will be a great loser	وَلَيْنِ أَطَعْتُمْ بَشَرًا مِثْلَكُمْ إِنَّكُمْ إِذَا لَخَاسِرُونَ
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“إِذَا” (*iza*) also means ‘when’, ‘at which time’. Surah *Shoora* says:

42:37	When they are angered then they protect others from the damaging influence of their anger.	وَإِذَا مَا غَضِبُوا هُمْ يَغْمُرُونَ
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“أَذُنُّ” (*aznun*) and “أَذُنُّ” (*uznun*): ears, the plural of which is “أَذَانٌ” (*aazaan*). “أَازَنُ” (*aazan*): a person who has large ears, and “أَازَنُ” (*azan*): somebody who listens to (obeys), and accepts whatever is said. Quran says:

9:61	(Opponents say about) the Messenger that he believes everything he hears	النَّبِيُّ وَيَقُولُونَ هُوَ أَدْنُ
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“أَذَانٌ” (*aazan*): an announcement.

9:3	This is an announcement from Allah and His Messenger to the people	وَأَذَانٌ مِّنَ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ إِلَى النَّاسِ
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“أَازِنُ إِلَيْهِ وَلَهُ” (*aazina ileihi walahu*): to listen attentively, willingly, but some feel that the liking or disliking is not implied. Some dictionary scholars say that this has a connotation of obeying along with listening. As such, to them: “وَأَذِنْتُ لِرَبِّيَهَا وَحَقَّتْ” (84:2, 84:5): not only ‘to listen’ but also ‘to obey’.

“تَأَذَّنُ” (*ta-azana*): announce or give some news to somebody. But some others think it means to swear {T}.

Actually it does have the connotation of swearing and belief. The teller says, verily I’ll do it. As such where Surah *Al-Ahzaf* says:

7:167	And your Sustainer announced that He will do it.	وَإِذْ تَأَذَّنَ رَبُّكَ
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(By God’s announcement or saying something definitely would mean that he has made a law (for something).

“إِذْنٌ بِالشَّيْءِ” means ‘to find out about something’; ‘to be aware of it’ {T}.

2:279	for God has announced war against you	فَأَذْنُونا بِحَرْبٍ مِّنَ اللَّهِ
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“إِذْنٌ لَهُ فِي الشَّيْءِ” (*azina lahu fishai-i*): ‘to give permission’, and “إِسْتِئْذَانٌ” (*istaezan*): ‘to seek permission’.

“إِذْنٌ” (*izn*): permission, announcement and awareness. “فَعَلَهُ بِإِذْنِي” (*fa’alahu bi izni*): ‘he did it with my knowledge’. {T}

Ibn Faris says that it means ‘ear’ as well as and ‘knowledge’.

Raghib says “إِذْنٌ” (*izn*) and “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) (knowledge) differ as “إِذْنٌ” (*izn*) is used when the intent and willingness of the one with knowledge is included, but it is not necessarily the case with “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*), therefore, *iznillah* would mean both the knowledge and permission of Allah. Ordinarily this is known as God’s law or rule. (Its details will be found under the heading “Sh-Y”). Thus, in the Quran, wherever “إِذْنٌ” (*iznu-llahi*) appears, both His knowledge and Will are intended.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says,

7:58	And good result comes forth from it, according to Steiner’s “إِذْنٌ” (rule).	وَالْبَلَدُ الطَّيِّبُ يَخْرِجُ نَبَاتُهُ بِإِذْنِ رَبِّهِ
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It is obvious that God has a law regarding agriculture, and crops appear according to this law.

The Quran says:

22:65	He holds back the clouds (rain) so that it doesn’t fall onto the earth without his “إِذْنٌ”	وَيُمْسِكُ السَّمَاءَ أَنْ تَقَعَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِهِ
3:145	No <i>nafs</i> comes to rest, unless according to Allah’s laws	وَمَا كَانَ لِنَفْسٍ أَنْ تَمُوتَ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ

This means that all living things die according to a law (of God / Nature).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:102	But they hurt no one, except according to Allah’s law	وَمَا هُمْ بِضَارِّينَ بِهِ مِنْ أَحَدٍ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ
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This means that Allah has enabled man to be hurt by the harm inflicted by another.

Stones do not have this characteristic. This is what “إِذْنٌ” (*izn*) is. This is the announced law of God.

Different things having different characteristics that determine their existence, is called God’s law which manifests itself in the form of Law of Nature. And as far the life of human society is concerned, this “إِذْنٌ” (*izn*) is written in the Book of God (the Quran).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:213	And guides those who are <i>Momineen</i> towards the truth about things that they (people) differ in, according to the law (in the book)	فَهَدَى اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لِمَا اخْتَلَفُوا فِيهِ مِنَ الْحَقِّ بِإِذْنِهِ
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Here “إِذْنٌ” (*izn*): the Book of God (the Quran) which holds the announced law.

If it is taken to mean ordinary law, then it would mean that God guides people (believers) according to the law of guidance and guidance is begotten by those who seek guidance. Those who don’t seek guidance, remain astray. However, “إِذْنٌ” (*izn*) of Allah means God’s law or the rule of guidance as contained in the Quran.

“الْأَذْيَةُ” (*al-aziyah*): something that is unpleasant, unwanted, slight botheration. When this increases, it becomes “ضَرَرٌ” (*zarar*) which means much pain, or trouble. “أَذَى” (*aziy*) or “يُؤْذِي” (*yoziy*): to hurt somebody. In other words, to say something that is unpleasant for others to hear {T}.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that its derivation could be “إِيْذَاءٌ” (*iyza*), but this word has not been noticed anywhere in the Arabic language. “نَاقَةُ أَذْيَةٍ” (*naqata aziyah*) is used for a female camel which is restless by disposition.

Regarding a woman’s menstruation, the Quran says:

2:222	Tell them that it is a setback.	قُلْ هُوَ أَذَى
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Here the word gives the sense of displeasure, dirtiness, and slight unease. That is why men have been advised to stay away from women during these times.

The same surah states ahead:

2:264	After meeting other’s need, don’t create an unpleasant situation.....	لَا تُبْطِلُوا صَدَقَاتِكُمْ بِالْمَنِّ وَالْأَذَى
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If you do so, then your help will have a destructive effect instead of constructive results, or your act will come to naught.

In a sense of punishing, this word appears in following verse

4:16	And the two among you who commit this act, punish them.	وَاللَّذَانِ يَأْتِيَانِيَا مِنْكُمْ فَأَذُوهُمَا
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Regarding the pain (in sickness) surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:196	Then whoso among you who are sick or have a headache.	فَمَنْ كَانَ مِنْكُمْ مَّرِيضًا أَوْ بِهِ أَذَى مِّن رَّأْسِهِ
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Ibn Faris says it has four basic meanings: need, intellect, a part, to tie a knot or to make something harder.

“الْأَرْبُ” (*al-arab*), “الْإِرْبَةُ” (*al-irbah*) or “الْأُورْبَةُ” (*al-urbah*): cunningness, insight, wittiness, complete organ from which nothing is missing, intellect, and expanse.

“أَرَبٌ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*araba bisha'iy*): to be expert of something.

“أَرَبَ إِلَيْهِ” (*ariba ileihi*): “he felt urgent need of”, or “lacked it”.

“الْأَرْبُ” (*al-arbu*): that distance (expanse) between the forefinger and the human middle finger.

“أَرَبُ الشَّيْءِ” (*arrabusheiyu*): “to strengthen something, to make it complete” {M}.

“الْأَرْبُ” (*al-arabu*): intensity, need, or requirement.

“الْإِرْبَةُ” (*al-irbah*) or “الْمَارْبَةُ” (*al-marabah*): need or requirement.

“أَرَابٌ” (*aarabun*) is the most essential organ. {R}

Surah *Tahaa* says:

20:18	“This will fulfill my many other needs” or “I will solve many other problems with this” or “I will get such insight from it as will help widen my understanding” or “I will get help from it in many different matters.”	وَلِي فِيهَا مَارِبٌ أُخْرَى
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Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:31	Such servants (among men) who don’t (have) the need (to marry).	غَيْرُ أُولَى الْإِرْبَةِ مِنَ الرِّجَالِ
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This may include servants who do lowly chores, or do not possess much intellect and who are not bothered with anything other than their meals, or who cannot in any way be attractive. This term of the Quran is very composite.

Anything that is low is called “أَرْضٌ” (*arz*), opposite to “سَمَاءٌ” (*sama*). As such, “أَرْضُ النَّعْلِ” (*arzun-na'li*): the sole of the shoe. Besides that, the part of the leg below the knee is also called “أَرْضٌ” (*arz*). The earth is also called “أَرْضٌ” (*arz*) because it is under one's feet. {T}

Since the basis of all human economics is the earth, the word “الْأَرْضَةُ” (*al-arzah*): wellbeing {T}. “أَرْضَتْ” (*arzatil-arz*): that the land has become productive. Since it has become very productive it has also become pleasing to the eye. “جَدْيٌ أَرِضٌ” (*jadyun arizun*): a fat kid (young goat). “أَرْضُ” (*arzu*) also means a termite {T}.

Since “أَرْضٌ” (*arzun*): something below, that is why “أَرَضَةٌ” (*arazah*): humble and obedient. “أَرِضٌ” (*ariza*) also means a kind man, or nation, or fine land. {F}

In the Quran, the word “أَرْضٌ” appears along with the word “جِبَالٌ”

18:47	During when we move the “جِبَالٌ”, then you shall see “أَرْضٌ” come forth	وَيَوْمَ نُسَيِّرُ الْجِبَالَ وَتَرَى الْأَرْضَ بَارِزَةً
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Here *jibaal* would mean the prominent people and *arz* the common people.

“أَرْضٌ وَ سَمَوَاتٌ” (*arzun wa samawatun*) would mean the highs and lows of the universe.

Where ever these words have anything to do with any segment of human life, then “سَمَاءٌ” (*sama*) would mean God's law for the universe and “أَرْضٌ” (*arz*) would mean man's economic life.

Quran says:

7:10	We have kept the means of economy in it (the earth)	وَجَعَلْنَا لَكُمْ فِيهَا مَعَايِشَ
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Deliberation on this will bring one to the conclusion that the real basis of human economy is the earth. That is why this word has also been used for channels of food. If economic life is separated from God's universal law or the way of life which the Quran has ordained, then human life is degraded to a very low level of animal life in which benefits of the biological life may be attained, but the high ideals of human life are not. This economic life has been described by the Quran as benefits of this near (short) life, and it has been described as depth against height.

7:169	Benefits of this low (life)	عَرَضَ هَذَا الْأَدْنَى
7:176	If We would have desired, We could have raised him, but he was attached to the earth.	وَلَوْ شِئْنَا لَرَفَعْنَاهُ بِهَا وَلَكِنَّهُ أَخْلَدَ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ

So, what the verses are saying is that “We wanted to give loftiness to him (Man) through our law of economics but he clung to lowliness.”

In other words, considering the interests of this biological life as the only reason of life has been described as selfishness or self-interest and vested interest.

In the language of the Quran:

7:176	And he (man) gave in to his own will	وَاتَّبَعَ هَوَاهُ
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Tauheed (to follow God) is that the external universal laws are to be implemented in the human economic life. This law is attained through *wahi* (Revelation) and is to be found in the Quran. **Tauheed** demands the same order of things to operate in the universe as well as on earth.

43:84	He is the Lord in the skies and the earth	وَهُوَ الَّذِي فِي السَّمَاءِ إِلَهٌ وَفِي الْأَرْضِ إِلَهٌ
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If Man, instead of Allah's law, adopts his self-made laws, then inequities make life unbearable.

21:21	Have they raised gods from earth they raise?	أَمْ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَةً مِّنَ الْأَرْضِ هُمْ يُنشِرُونَ
21:22	If there were gods in them, besides Allah, they would surely have been ruined	لَوْ كَانَ فِيهِمَا آلِهَةٌ إِلَّا اللَّهُ لَفَسَدَتَا

If there be in the skies and the earth any other power (other than Allah) then this whole system would be destroyed.

As mentioned earlier, “أَرْضٌ” (the earth) is the source of food for all humanity. This means that it cannot be owned by any individual.

55:10	the earth has been created for the creatures	وَالْأَرْضَ وَضَعَهَا لِلْأَنَامِ
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At another place, it is said:

80:32	for you and your animals	مَتَاعًا لَّكُمْ وَلِأَنعَامِكُمْ
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Not only the earth but other elements which combine to produce crop from the land, are “وَمَتَاعًا لِلْمُقْوِينَ” 56:73 (life’s sustenance for the hungry). Thus, any system in which, instead of for the benefit of the entire humanity, the earth becomes the tool for a particular group or individuals’ benefit is against God’s will. As such, the Quran says that this fountainhead of all “*rizq*” (sustenance) must remain accessible to all the needy

41:10	He placed the solid rock high up on it, and blessed it, and arranged a way for the four seasons, to all who seek (on an equal footing).	وَجَعَلَ فِيهَا رَوَاسِيَ مِّنْ فَوْقِهَا وَبَارَكَ فِيهَا وَقَدَّرَ فِيهَا أَقْوَاتَهَا فِي أَرْبَعَةِ أَيَّامٍ سَوَاءً لِّلنَّاسِ لَيْلٍ
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The factors of production and life’s sustenance i.e. light, wind, water, earth etc. should be under a Quranic society which adopts a system that provides for all. This revolutionary program was given by the Quran when the world thought of “feudalism” as being “very natural”.

The world at that time was unable to grasp the importance of this message (and later it was put on the back burner by even the Muslims) but once again, due to the exigencies of time, the world is striving towards that very goal (abolishing feudalism).

This is the fact pointed out by the Quran saying:

13:41	do they not see how we snatch the land from the big feudal and diminish it	أَوَلَمْ يَرَوْا أَنَّا نَأْتِي الْأَرْضَ نَنْقُصُهَا مِنْ أَطْرَافِهَا
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Gradually, the time will come when land will not belong to any particular person and will provide sustenance for everybody. This will be the time about which it has been said:

39:66	The earth will glow with the light of its sustained.	وَأَشْرَقَتِ الْأَرْضُ بِنُورِ رَبِّهَا
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Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is “to rest”.

Raghib says that four legged bed is called “رَيْكَةٌ” (*aarikah*) because it generally is made from a wood called “رَاكٌ” (*aarak*).

“الرَيْكَةُ” (*al-arikah*), with plural “رَايِكٌ” (*araika*): a throne or resting place surrounded by curtains, or any other thing used for leaning.

“الرَّاكُ” (*al-arak*): a kind of bitter fodder. This fodder is not sour but salty and bitter. Camels eat it after taking their meal so that it can help them digest their food.

The Quran says:

18:31	they will rest against boards with cushions (or on beds)	مُتَّكِئِينَ فِيهَا عَلَى الْأَرَائِكِ
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Its meaning is that they will be comfortable. Moreover, beside the type of wood or tree, “رَاكٌ” (*arak*) or “رَيْكٌ” (*rik*) is that wound which heals and the skin gets levelled again, because it has come back to its original shape.

Ibn Faris says that it means ‘to stack things on one another’. This has both connotations i.e. arrangement (order) and loftiness (height).

“الْأَرَامُ” (*al-aramu*) with singular “أَرَمٌ” (*aram*): footprints, or to mark something so as to recognize it. Stones too, are called “أَرَمٌ” (*arram*). {M}

Quran says about the nation of *Aad*:

89:7	With the pillar raised <i>Iram</i>	إِرمَ ذَاتِ الْعِمَادِ
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“إِرمَ” (*iram*) is perhaps the name of the place they dwelled.

Raghib says that 89:7 means those lofty pillars which were engraved. Some researchers think that *Iram* was their chief who was the son of *Saam*. This would mean that *Iram* and *Aad* is the name of the same nation. The compiler of *Muheet* says that “الْأَرْوَمَةُ” (*al-aromah*): ‘the roots of a tree’ or ‘human descent’.

“الْأَزْرُ” (*alizru*): backup force, strength to rely upon.

Quran says:

20:31	Strengthen my back by it	اشْدُدْ بِهِ أَزْرِي
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“الْأَزْرُ” (*al-izru*): the basic backup strength.

“الْأَزَارُ” (*al-izaru*): anything that can work as cover for your body (especially for the genitals).

“الْمُؤَاَزَرَةُ” (*al-mowazarah*): to confront, or to help each other; bundling of crops with each other in such a manner that the bigger plants support the smaller ones.

“أَزَرَ” (*azara*): to strengthen the roots or basis of something.

Surah *Al-Fateh* says (about the tree of Islam):

48:29	(Like the crops that first takes out its needle) and then strengthens its roots and so keeps getting thick.	فَازِرَةً فَاسْتَعْظَمَ
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“أَزَرُ” (*azaru*) was the name of the idol protected by Ibrahim’s father *Tarukh* (the Biblical *Terah*). With reference to the idol, his title was “*Azar*”. Some say that “*Azar*” was Ibrahim’s uncle or some other elder relative.

But the Quran says:

6:74	Once said Ibrahim to his father <i>Azar</i> ...	وَإِذْ قَالَ إِبْرَاهِيمُ لِأَبِيهِ أَزَرَ
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Since no other meaning can be taken, “*Azar*” was indeed his father. Some even say that it was “*Tarukh*” which was transformed into the name “*Azar*”. But this is a weak argument. Some have said that “*Azar*” means “*zal’al*” (astray) but this word has not been used in the Quran for this meaning.

A-Z-Z أ ز ز

Ibn Faris says that this root basically means ‘to move’, movement, or ‘to dislodge’. In short, it means to instigate someone in such a way that they can’t realize that they are being instigated.

- “الْأَزِيرُ” (*al-azeer*): sharpness, heat or thunder.
- “الْأَزِيرُ” (*al-azeer*): sharpness, heat or thunder.
- “أَزَّ النَّارُ زَبُورَهَا” (*azzanna zabzuha*): he lit the fire and stoked it
- “أَزَّتْ الْقَدْرُ” (*azzati-lqamar*): the pot boiled up
- “أَزَّتْ السَّحَابَةُ” (*azzati-ssahabah*): the clouds thundered loudly
- “الْأَزُّ” (*al-azzu*): the twitching of a vein, or to rouse (in anger)

Surah *Maryam* says

19:83	they instigate and arouse	تَوَزَّهُمْ أَزَّا
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A-Z-F أ ز ف

Ibn Faris says the basic concept of the word is of nearness and being close by.

- “أَزَفَ الرَّحْلُ” (*azfarrahal*): time to depart has come near.
- “أَزَفَ الرَّجُلُ” (*azfarrajul*): the man hurried up.
- “أَتَّأَزَفُ” (*at-tazuf*) is ‘to take short, measured step’s.
- “الْأَزِفُ” (*al-azif*): ‘that will happen shortly’.

The Quran says:

83:57	The moment to be approached, has approached	أَزِفَتْ الْأَزِفَةُ
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Or, in other words, the time for results (of one’s acts) has come.

At another place, it is said:

20:18	the moment which was due (the time for revolution)	يَوْمَ الْأَزِفَةِ
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Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that words in which “ز” (*za*) comes together with “ا” (*hamza*), have a connotation of harshness, and narrowness.

“إِسْتَبْرَقُ” (*istabraq*): ‘thick silk cloth’. Some say that it is a thick silk cloth on which there is gold embroidery.

The Quran says

18:31	Clothes of silk and embroidery	سُنْدُسٍ وَإِسْتَبْرَقٍ
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The author of *Taj-ul-Uroos* reports that, according to an author Jowhari, the word’s root is “بَرَقَ” (*baraq*) meaning lightning. If so, then it may carry the connotation of bright as lightning.

Two sons of *Ibrahim* have been mentioned in the Quran. The elder one, *Ismail*, was from his wife *Haajar* and the younger son, *Ishaq* “إِسْحَاقُ” (*is-haaq*), was from his wife *Sarah*.

Ismail settled in the valley of *Hijaz* and *Is-haaq* led the Palestinians. God has mentioned *Is-haaq* in the category of messengers.

2:140	and that which was bestowed (revealed) unto <i>Ibrahim, Ismail</i> and <i>Is-haaq</i>	أَمْ تَقُولُونَ إِنَّ إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْمَاعِيلَ وَإِسْحَاقَ
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The Israelite messengers were from among their progeny.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is to stop, or to imprison someone.

“الْأَسَارُ” (*al-asaru*): the string or shoelace by which something is bound.

“الْأَسْرُ” (*al-asru*): to bind something with a rope etc. It also means ‘to be bound’, ‘form’ and ‘creation’.

“الْأَسِيرُ” (*al-aseer*): a prisoner, a tied up man.

The plural is “أَسَارِي” (*asariy*) or “أَسْرِي” (*asariy*).

The connotation of tying can also indicate meanings like ‘strong’ and ‘stable’.

The Quran has used the word “أَسَارِي” (*usara*) for ‘prisoners’.

The Quran says:

2:85	And when they come before you as prisoners	وَإِنْ يَأْتُوكُمْ أَسَارِي
76:29	We created them (human beings) and bound their “ <i>asr</i> ” strongly	خَلَقْنَاهُمْ وَشَدَدْنَا أَسْرَهُمْ

In this sense *asr* means the human body, or its form.

In the light of modern day science, it is seen that this points towards a very important fact. We cannot feel something if it doesn’t have a form. Science tells us that matter in reality is not something solid. This is a conglomeration of atoms which cling to each other or are bound together according to some laws of nature or of God, and if this binding force was to be absent, then nothing would have a shape or form. Thus it is this *asr* or mutual binding force which gives form to things.

Sir James Jeans says that everything is connected, by “bottled up waves”.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that in words where a *sin* “س” appears along with a *hamza* “أ”, a connotation of strength and intensity is present.

This was the title of **Yaqoob** as in 3:94. For details, see the heading “**Yaqoob**”. For Bani Israel, see the heading “**Bani Israel**”.

A-S-S

ا س س

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is for something to remain in its place, or to be well-established.

“الأسس” (*al-assu*) or “الأساس” (*al-asaasu*) is the foundation of a building. Plural is “أساس” (*asaasu*).
 “الأسيس” (*al-asyu*): the core of something;
 “التأسيس” (*at-tasisu*) is to lay the foundation of a building.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that in words where a *sin* “س” appears along with a *hamza* “أ”, a connotation of strength and intensity is present.

Surah **At-Tauba** says:

9:108	A mosque which is founded on (based on) <i>taqwa</i>	أَبْدَأَ الْمَسْجِدَ أُسُّ عَلَى التَّقْوَى
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“الأسس” (*al-assu*) is also used to describe the human heart, and also the dust or ashes that are left behind by a departing caravan. This actually signifies some influence or mark of something.

“خُذَّاسُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*khuzassu tareeq*) is said to someone when he is told to reach the destination with the help of the right indications or markings along the road.

A-S-F

ا س ف

Ibn Faris says it means to lose something and then feel sorrow and longing for it.

“الأسف” (*al-asaf*): the great grief and sorrow one feels on losing something or someone.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that in words where a *sin* “س” appears along with a *hamza* “أ”, a connotation of strength and intensity is present.

Surah **Al-Ahzaf** says that the following about **Moosa** (Moses) when he came back towards his nation:

7:150	And when Moosa came back he was furious and in sorrow	وَلَمَّا رَجَعَ مُوسَى إِلَى قَوْمِهِ غَضْبَانَ أَسِفًا
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According to **Raghib**, it means the boiling of one’s blood due to vengeful emotions.

If one feels this way for someone beneath his position, it is called “غَضَبٌ” (*ghazab*). And if is felt for a superior/higher person, it is called “حُزْنٌ” (*huzn*).

The Quran says the following about Allah:

43:55	When they displeased Us, We punished them for their crimes.	فَلَمَّا آسَفُونَا انْتَقَمْنَا مِنْهُمْ
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For the details around the subject of displeasing Allah, see the topic of (**Gh-Zd-B**).

In surah Yusuf, **Yaqoob** says:

12:84	O how I grief for Yosef .	يَا أَسْفَى عَلَى يُوسُفَ
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In ordinary circumstances, therefore, it means woe and sorrow.

“أَرْضٌ أَسِيفَةٌ” (*arzun asifah*): that land which is barren.

“الْجَمَلُ الْأَسِيفُ” (*aljamalu al-asifu*): the camel which doesn’t fatten (**Ibn Faris**).

“أَسِيفٌ” (*asifu*) also means slave, because the slave is always sorrowful about the loss of his freedom.

Besides this, this word is also used for one who becomes sad easily.

Ismail

اسْمَاعِيل

The Quran mentions the two sons of Ibrahim. Ismail was the elder son who was from the first wife Hajar. He is the one whom Ibrahim meant to sacrifice, in accordance with a dream from Allah (37:102)

But God kept him alive for a lifetime of sacrifice instead of the immediate sacrifice. (37:107)

That great sacrifice was the (re) birth of the Ka'aba (the House of God) and its safe keeping. As such, both father and son (Ibrahim and Ismail) together built the Ka'aba (21:127). Afterwards, Ismail settled there for its safe keeping, and God endowed him with Messenger hood (2:136), and called him “صَادِقٌ” (*sadiq-ul-wa'di*) 19:54.

Ismail is a combination of the Hebrew word “*shamah*” (to listen or obey) and the word “*ahl*” the people of God. Since his birth was in answer to Ibrahim's prayer, his name was Ismail (or one who listens or obeys God).

The last Messenger *Muhammad* was born among his descendants.

A-S-N

ا س ن

“أَسَنَ الْمَاءُ يَأْسُنُ” (*asanal ma-o yasuun*): when the taste, color or smell of something goes bad.

“أَلْسِنٌ” (*al-asin*): the water which has been petrified as result of being motionless. {T, M, R}

The Quran says the following about the canals in heaven:

47:15	In which there are canals of water which do not deteriorate	فِيهَا أَنْهَارٌ مِّنْ مَّاءٍ غَيْرٍ آسِنٍ
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The meaning is that in a heavenly society, nothing is stagnant. Each and every thing that is useful circulates.

On the contrary, the society of *Jahannum* is described as where:

107:7	(And they) Refuse to reach out.	وَيَمْتَنِعُونَ الْمَاعُونَ
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The above verse means that, in a society opposite to the Quranic society, people with power take control over the sources of production, money and things that are beneficial. They stop their circulation or flow within the people. This is done by those who enjoy power and hegemony, but this results in pollution in these resources due to lack of motion. (It is not possible for us to comprehend the conditions of next stage of life in this world but) the Quran also tells us about the Heaven and Hell on this earth. We can see such societies with our own eyes. The Heaven and Hell in the Hereafter are the basis of our Belief. Quran only describes them allegorically as in 47:15 and 13:35.

Ibn Faris says that “أَسُو” (*asu*) basically means to treat an ill condition and it also means to woe and feel sorrow.

“أَسَيْتُ عَلَيْهِ” (*aseetu a’laihi*): I felt sorry for that.

“رَجُلٌ أَسٍ وَ أَسِيَانٌ” (*rajulun asi wa asyan*): a grieving man.

“الْأَس” (*al-as*): a physician or doctor.

“إِمْرَأَةٌ أَسِيَّةٌ” (*imratun aseeh*): a grieving woman.

“أَسَاهُ بِمُصِيبَةٍ تَأْسِيَةً” (*as-sahu bimuseebatin ta’aseyah*): sympathized with him in his woe

“فَتَأْسَى” (*fata’as-saya*): so he got solace

The Quran says:

5:26	Therefore, don’t be grieved at the destruction of the nation of <i>faseqeen</i>	فَلَا تَأْسَ عَلَى الْقَوْمِ الْفَاسِقِينَ
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Raghib says that “أَسَى” (*asann*): sorrow and “تَأْسِيَةً” (*tasiya*): to remove that sorrow.

As such, “الْأَسْو” (*al-aswu*) also means a healing medicine.

“الْأَسِيَّةُ” (*al-asiyatun*): medicines, which is the plural of “الْأَسْو” (*al-asu*). “الْأَسِي” (*al-asiyo*) is the subject that gets treated.

“أَسَوْتُهُ بِهِ” (*asautuhu behi*): “I considered it to be an example to be followed”.

Raghib says that “أَسْوَةٌ” (*asa*) or “أُسْوَةٌ” (*uswatun*) is the condition of a person while obeying a command whether good or bad, pleasant or unpleasant. Besides this, it also means something that gives solace to a grieving man, something that mitigates his sorrow, something that can be the answer to one’s troubles.

{T}{R}

Those who were weak and unstable during the *Ahzaab* battle were told:

33:21	you should have done what Allah’s Messenger did	لَقَدْ كَانَ لَكُمْ فِي رَسُولِ اللَّهِ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ
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In other word, the way in which he faced all troubles according to the laws of God and with solidarity and strong will, you should do likewise. His example was the best example for you. You should have found solace in it. Likewise, it has been mentioned about Ibrahim at another place that he told the opponents of God’s order publicly that “there is no relationship between you and me.”

In this context it was said:

60:4	In Ibrahim and those who were with his, is a balanced example for you	قَدْ كَانَتْ لَكُمْ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ فِي إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَالَّذِينَ مَعَهُ
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This act of Ibrahim and his companions is an example for you to follow. This will redress your sorrow. As such, the believers have been told at many places in the Quran, to not keep any relation with the opponents of God’s order. They are told to not make them their confidantes.

3:118	Don’t make anyone as confidantes except your own (believers).	لَا تَتَّخِذُوا بِطَانَةً مِّن دُونِكُمْ
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“الْمُؤَاسَاةُ” (*almu-asato*): to consider the other in your place (and strive for as much benefit for him as you would for yourself, and strive to remove as much ill effect from him as from yourself). It is considered as sacrifice when you prefer someone else above self.

The Quran teaches sacrifice:

59:9	they prefer others over themselves	وَيُؤْثِرُونَ عَلَى أَنفُسِهِمْ
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The Quranic social order of *Rabubiya* (welfare) is based upon this principle.

The basic meanings of this root are ‘heat’ and ‘intensity’. {F}

“أَشِيرَ” (*ashira*), “يَاشُرُ” (*yasharu*), “أُشْرَ” (*ushran*): to be overly proud and vain; to be pleased with oneself.

The term “أَشْرُ الْمُنْجَلِ” (*usharul minjal*) is used to signify the teeth of a saw, while “الْمُنْشَارُ” (*al-minshar*): “saw”.

As such “أُشْرَ” (*ashrun*) is such a self-liking, that cuts into others; liking oneself in such a way that it bothers other people, and is disliked; in other words, such pride that goes beyond the norms of human act.

The Quran says:

54:25	On the contrary, he is denier of pride. (He is a great denier and a narcissist).	بَلْ هُوَ كَذَّابٌ أَشِرٌ
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This “أَشِيرَ” (*ashira*) is derived from “يَاشُرُ” (*ya-shiro*) which means great pride and narcissism.

Al-Ukhdod

الاخدود

It refers to the army of **Zunawas**, the ruler of the **Tubba** nation, who threw the Christians in big, burning trenches (85:49). For details, see heading (**T-B-Ain**) and (**Kh-D-D**).

Al-Aikah

الايكه

The nation towards which **Shoaib** (Jethro) was sent has been called **Ashab-ul-Aikah**. 15:78
For details see heading “**Shoaib**”.

Al-Hijr

الحجر

Ismail’s elder son was named **Nabayeth**. His family is called **Nabath** (plural Anbat). The ruins of his kingdom can be found all over Syria and Arabia. The Torah mentions **Nabath** in the chapter about the Messenger **Hizqeel**. At first, his capitol was **Raqeem**, but when it was occupied by the Romans, he migrated to the city of **Hijr** in the valley of Qura’a. They (the people) have been called **Ashab-ul-Hijr** in this context. They denied God’s orders and were involved in **Azaaab** (God’s punishment). Since the nation of **Samuud** was also in the city of Hijr, some historians think that Ashabul-Hijr means the nation of **Samuud**. But the guess prevails that Ashab-ul-Hijr means the nation of **Nabath** whose tales of rise and fall can still be traced in the ruins of Hijr.

Al-Rass

الرس

Ismail settled in **Hijaz**. He had twelve sons who were the head of their dynasties. One of them was **Qaidmah**. **Ashab-ur-Rass** are said to be from among his descendants. Some think that it was one of the tribes of the nation **Samuud**. In connection with the denial of God’s orders, they have been mentioned at two places in the Quran (25:48) and (50:12).

Those young men who were preparing for a celestial revolution while they sought refuge in a cave, have been mentioned in Surah *Al-Kahaf* (18:9-26). Details will be found in my book *Shola'eh Mastoor*.

The city of *Raqeem* was the capital of the *Nabti* [Nubia] government during ancient times. When the Romans conquered Syria and Palestine, this city came to the limelight but not as *Raqeem* city but as *Petra* city which was called *Batra* by the Arabs. Modern archaeology has found the ruins. This city was situated on the highway from Hijaz to Syria. As such, at the time of the revelation (of the Quran), the Arabs were aware of the tales of the *Ashab-ul-Kahaf* (Companions of the Cave) or the *Ashab-ur-Raqeem* (Companions of Batra) but only so much as was known to the common man.

The Quran (without going into the details) revealed what in fact their purpose was and what people later took them to be. For more details see heading R-Q-M.

A-Sd-D

أ ص د

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is 'merging of one thing into another'.

“أَصَدَّ” (*asud*): – ‘he closed (the door etc)’.

“أَلْأَصِيدُ” (*al-aseed*): a cage where animals are kept locked up.

The Quran has used “مُؤَصَّدَةٌ” (*musadatun*) which means ‘closed’, or ‘constituting of’.

Compilers of dictionaries maintain that it is a part of the root “وَصَدَّ” (*wasad*), so we have also mentioned it there (i.e under the heading *W-Sd-D*) even though we think that it is a permanent root.

A-Sd-R

ا ص ر

The basic meaning of this root is to make someone stop or bow, that is, to subjugate somebody {*F*}.

“أَلْأَصْرُ” (*al-asr*): to tie something up; forcibly stop {*T*}

“أَلْأَصِرَّةُ” (*al-aseerato*) is a small rope with which the lower part of a tent is bound firmly {*M*}.

“أَلْأَصْرُ” (*al-isro*): a firm command to which a human being is firmly bound (adherent). It also means ‘burden’.

Surah *Al-Araaf* says about the Messenger:

7:157	He will ease the burden which mankind has been burdened with	وَيَضَعُ عَنْهُمْ إِصْرَهُمْ
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That means that he will lift the severe prohibitions that are unbearable for humans and, in this way, will give Mankind the real freedom of thought and action.

It is this very “إِصْرٌ” (*isrun*) with which we have been taught to think freely.

The Quran says:

2:286	And do not burden us with such load	وَلَا تَحْمِلْ عَلَيْنَا إِصْرًا
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This is the real freedom granted by the Quran. In other words, only God's orders, nobody else's, not even of religious figures or worldly leaders (if their orders are against God's orders), will be obeyed in this world (3:78).

Raghib says that “أَلْأَصْرُ” (*al-isr*): those elements which prevent or stop someone from following the path of virtuousness.

“أَصْلُ” (*al-asl*) is the lowest part of something. “أَصْلٌ” (*asl*) is the basis or foundation of something.

This word has appeared in the Quran as against “فَرْعٌ” (*far-un*) which means the highest point of something.

14:24	Strong foundation and peaks in the heights	أَصْلُهَا ثَابِتٌ وَفَرْعُهَا فِي السَّمَاءِ
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“إِسْتَأْصَلَهُ” (*asta-slah*) – ‘it was rooted out’, ‘pulled from its roots’ or ‘cut’. “الْأَصِيلُ” (*al-aseel*) is used for the time from *asr* to *maghrib* (from afternoon till twilight).

The Quran says:

7:205	... Morning and evening...	بِالْعُدُوِّ وَالْأَصَالِ
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Ibn Faris says that it means the time after the evening. This is probably said in the context of the basic part of the night.

According to **Ragib**, “أَصْلٌ” (*as-lun*): the basic part of a thing which, if removed, destroys that thing. Thus the time between *asr* and *maghrib* is called “الْأَصِيلُ” (*al-aseel*) because when that ends, the day ends as well.

Ibn Faris says it basically means something being unpleasant.

“الْأُفُّ” (*al-uff*) is used for every dirty, acrimonious, and degraded thing, such as dirt, nail pairing, the dirt between the nails, ear wax etc. The word “الْفُتْبِ” (*uftabin*) is used when you rub off, or blow away dirt or ash from your clothes.

It seems that in connection with blowing away, “الْأُفْتَةُ” (*al-uftah*): a coward, or somebody who has nothing of significance, one who has little wealth, a dirty man.

“الْأُفُّ” (*al-afaf*): to be tired of.

“الْأُفُّ” (*al-uf*): bad smell.

“أُفٌّ” (*u-fo*): unease, tire of, or due to some pain say “*uf*.” It is used to express tiredness (of somebody), or to degrade somebody “أُفٌّ لَهْ” (*uffin lahu*) will be used.

About parents, the Quran says:

17:23	Do not degrade them or do not scold them (talk to them harshly).	فَلَا تَقُلْ لَهُمَا أُفٍّ وَلَا تَنْهَرْهُمَا وَقُلْ لَهُمَا قَوْلًا كَرِيمًا
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Present time is also described by this word, but the Quran has not used it in this meaning.

Ibn Faris says it basically means the expanse or polarization between two ends of a thing.

“الْأَفَقُ” (*al-ufaq*): corner (horizon). The plural is “أَفَقٌ” (*aafaqun*), meaning everything in between heaven and earth that is in your visual range.

The Quran says:

41:53	we will show them our signs around the world and also within themselves	سَنُرِيهِمْ آيَاتِنَا فِي الْأَفَاقِ وَفِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ
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Meaning is of national and international calamities. It could also mean the external universe and the human world.

“أَفَقُ الْبَيْتِ” (*ufaqul bait*) is a tent’s front porch.

“فَرَسٌ أَفَقٌ” (*farasun ufaq*): a delightful horse with amazing speed.

“أَفَقَ الرَّجُلُ” (*ufaqir rajul*): that he reached excellence in knowledge, nobility and other traits.

Regarding great loftiness and expanse, it is said about the Messenger:

81:23	and He found him in great loftiness (God found the Messenger at a high place in character)	وَلَقَدْ رَآهُ بِالْأَفْئِ الْمُبِينِ
53:7	(The messenger) is at a high pedestal (of knowledge and humanism).	وَهُوَ بِالْأَفْئِ الْأَعْلَى

Ibn Faris says it basically means to overturn something or divert something from its path.

“أَفَكٌ” (*afak*) or “يَافِكُ” (*yafiko*): to tell a lie, to fabricate, to divert someone from his rightful path {T}.

“إِئْتَفَكَ” (*i’tafak*): can hold the connotation of deviating from the right path and fabricating lies.

“الْمُؤْتَفِكَاتُ” (*al-mutafikaat*) also mean the winds which have deviated from their right path, therefore it may mean those dwellings (those who live in them) who have not stayed on the right path or who perform wrong deeds, fabricated lies. The Quran’s style reflects that they were certain dwellings where people lived and got destroyed.

46:11	They will say this is the same lie which has been fabricated since old times	فَسَيَقُولُونَ هَذَا إِفْكٌ قَالِمٌ
54:2	The lie that has been perpetrated since old times	سِحْرٌ مُسْتَوْرٌ

In Surah **An-Noor** the Quran warns the muslims not to fabricate false accusations and not to propagate such things in society (24:18, 24:4). It has also related an instance in this regard when a group falsely accused another group:

24:11	The people who have fabricated these lies is a group among you	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ جَاءُوا بِالْإِفْكِ عُصْبَةٌ مِنْكُمْ
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In this entire narration the Quran does not mention as to who it was who was falsely accused. It has only said that when the news (which was fabrication of false accusation) reached the momineen, they should have reacted by saying “بَذَا إِفْكٌ مُبِينٌ” (*haaza ifkun mubeen*) in 24:14, or “بَذَا بُهْتَانٌ عَظِيمٌ” (*haaza buhtanun azeem*) in 24:16 this is the same thing which has been clarified at another place by saying that when some *faasiq* tells you something, then investigate it (47:6).

Only this much has been said by the Quran but this event has been referred to Aisha (one of the wives of the messenger) and a whole story seems to have been built around it. It has said that even the Messenger himself was very troubled about this event, so much so that he had sent Aisha to her parents’ house and only when God had absolved her through a verse, had he brought her back.

It can be clearly seen that it was a fabricated tale, which was fabricated with ulterior motive. But we **Muslims** treat it as an historical event. When the opponents of Islam argue about it we tend to get angry, although in answer to such allegations we must say what the Quran has said:

24:12	This so-called event is an open lie and a big accusation	هَذَا إِفْكٌ مُّبِينٌ
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The Quran says about the staff of **Moosa**:

7:117	it destroyed (devoured) all that they had created	تَلَقَّفُ مَا يَأْفِكُونَ
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In surah **As-Saffat** it is said about the lying deniers:

37:86	Do you want to (go on) a diversion.....	أُفَيْكًا
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Surah **Ash-Shura** says:

26:222	Sinful liars	أَفَاكٌ أَثِيمٌ
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The Quran has explained this in surah **Al-Jasiya** by saying:

45:8	he listens to the laws of God, which are presented before him, then through pride, insists on what he believes, as if he didn't even hear the laws of God	يَسْمَعُ آيَاتِ اللَّهِ تُنْزِلُ عَلَيْهِ ثُمَّ يُصِرُّ مُسْتَكْبِرًا كَأَن لَّمْ يَسْمَعْهَا
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“إِفْكٌ” (**ifkun**): to overturn something, to change something from how it should have been like. **Raghib** too, thinks it has this meaning.

In this context, it appears in surah **Az-Zariyat**:

51:9	One only turns away when he himself wants to turn away	يُؤْفِكُ عَنْهُ مَنْ أَفَكَ
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This means that if one is willing, only then he can be turned away (from some teaching, belief etc.).

This points to a great fact that God doesn't lead anyone astray; it is man himself who lets him be led astray. God's law ordains that one who wants to go astray is not forced to select the right path. The initiative is in Man's hands. Whatever he does, right or wrong, God's law accordingly is applied on him. If he becomes hard like stone, then every glass that strikes him will be blown to smithereens, and if he becomes delicate like glass, then even a small stone will be enough to shatter it. God does not change one's direction forcibly.

61:5	When they went astray then A's law (the laws of nature) turned their hearts....”	فَلَمَّا زَاغُوا أَزَاغَ اللَّهُ قُلُوبَهُمْ
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5:75	the dwellings that were overturned	الَّتِي يُؤْفِكُونَ
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“الْأَفْكَةُ” (**al-ifkatoh**): the draught years. **{T}{R}**

“الْمَأْفُوكُ” (**al-mafuk**) is a place which is barren, due to lack of rain **{T, R}**.

”أَقَلَّ الْقَمَرُ أَفُولًا“ (*afalal qamaro ufula*): the appearance and disappearance of the moon (or other heavenly bodies).

”الْمُؤَفَّلُ“ (*al-muaffil*): defective or weak.

”رَجُلٌ مَاءٍ فَوَلُّ الرَّأْيِ“ (*rajaloon ma fulur ra'ee*): a dim witted man.

Raghib says that ”الْأَفُولُ“ (*al-ufool*): the sinking of bright stars.

Ibn Faris says it means sinking as well as to become small or dim.

The Quran says **Ibrahim** deliberated deeply over the system of the universe. He studied them (the heavenly bodies) and their strengths deeply.

6:75	and in this way we showed Ibrahim the highs and lows of the universe	وَكَذَلِكَ نُرِي إِبْرَاهِيمَ مَلَكُوتَ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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In this way strengthened his belief in God. As such, he saw the stars, deliberated on the moon, the sun and found out that at one time they burn very bright but at other times they are lost in darkness. As such, these things, which are subject to change, could not be his god. Only that which is not subject to change could be his God.

Therefore, he said:

6:75	I am not ready to worship things which are subject to change	لَا أُجِبُ الْآفِلِينَ
6:79	For me, God is one who is the Creator of all of them	فَطَرِ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ

This declaration that something which is subject to change cannot be worshipped points to a great reality. The basic characteristic of personality is that it is not subject to external factors, in the words of Bergson [the famous French philosopher (1859-1941)], this is “changelessness in change”. Therefore, God, which is the most complete and perfect personality will be totally devoid of change. Therefore, that which is subject to change or ”أَفَلٌ“ (*afal*) cannot be God.

Change is against the basic traits of personality. A person, whose personality is groomed, also bears this characteristic. He becomes firm in his principles and is not affected by external influences (like a weather cock). This is what is called firmness of belief and solidarity of actions. Such are the men who can be trusted. Those men whose God is not ”أَفَلٌ“ (*afal*) are not ”أَفَلٌ“ (*afal*) either. Like God, like individual or nation. The concept of God has a deep impression on a man’s personality or that of a nation. The concept of God, as presented by the Quran, is that the believers can be matched by no other, neither in strength and solidarity, nor in honor.

Ibn Faris says that this root basically means to diminish gradually, like when you eat a thing, it gets diminished gradually.

Hence “أَكَلَ” (*akul*): to chew something and then eat it. Something which one drinks or swallows without chewing is not called “مَأْكُولٌ” (*ma-kool*), “أَلْمَأْكُولُ” (*al-makool*): an animal which is eaten by a wild beast.

Surah **Al-Kahaf** says:

105:5	eaten, and cut (into small pieces of) fodder	كَعَصَفٍ مَّأْكُولٍ
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Hence it means fodder or leaves eaten by insects (moth-eaten).

“أَلَاكِيلُ” (*al-akeel*): a king and “أَلْمَأْكُولُ” (*al-makool*) are the subjects. “أَلَاكُولُ” (*al-ukul*) is generally used for fruits but any part of plants that is eaten is “أَلَاكُولُ” (*al-ukul*).

About the **Jannah** the Quran says:

13:35	its fruits will always remain (it will always have, or bear, fruit)	أَكُلُوهَا ذَاتِمٌ
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Provisions (*rizq*), intellect, opinion, and profound intellect are also called “أَلَاكُولُ” (*al-ukul*).

“أَكَلَ” (*aakul*) actually means “to eat”, but it also means “to take”:

3:129	do not “take” (charge) interest	لَا تَأْكُلُوا الرِّبَا
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Raghib writes that “أَكَلَ الْمَالُ” (*akal maal*) means charity because most of one’s money is spent on edibles and for meeting economic needs.

In surah **Al-Ma’ida** it is said in reference to **haram** (forbidden) items:

5:3	Carrion, unless you do a proper zibah [slaughter]	أَكَلِ السَّيِّئِ إِلَّا مَا ذَكَّيْتُمْ
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Carrion is an animal which has been devoured partly by beasts, and there is still life in it. This is followed by that if you slaughter in the Islamic way while saying Allah’s name (but not cutting off the throat completely) then it is allowed. If beasts have eaten it (some animal) completely, then there is no question of it being **haram** or **halal** (i.e. permissible or not). And if the animal has died then it becomes **haram** (forbidden).

This is used to specify a particular thing, exactly as “the” or “this” is used in English. “رَجُلٌ” (*rajul*) is some man. “الرَّجُلُ” (*al-rajul*) is “the” or “this” man. The closest English expression is the Definite Article ‘the.’ Following examples will clarify its usage:

- First mention or talk about someone/something is used ordinarily. Then, when mentioned again, “**al**” is added as prefix.

Example:

73:15	we sent a Messenger to Firoun	كَأَمَّا أَرْسَلْنَا إِلَىٰ فِرْعَوْنَ رَسُولًا
73:16	Then Firoun disobeyed this Messenger	فَعَصَىٰ فِرْعَوْنُ الرَّسُولَ

Here, “الرَّسُولُ” (*ar-rasul*): the afore-mentioned **rasul**.

To mention something/someone which or who the listener is already familiar with

For instance:

9:40	When the two were inside that cave	إِذْ هُمَا فِي الْغَارِ
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Here at first no cave was mentioned. It has been called “*al-ghaar*” even the very first time. This means that the listeners knew which “*ghaar*” or cave was being mentioned.

- When time or period is being fixed. As in

5:3	During this period, we have completed your <i>deen</i> (way of life or religion)	الْيَوْمَ أَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ
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- When the entire humanity is being discussed, or meaning full or entire as.

4:28	Man is created in such a way so as to become overwhelmed with emotions	وَخَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ ضَعِيفًا
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Here the characteristic of the entire human race is being described.

- When all things of its kind have been included in something, also then “al” is used. For example:

2:2	This book	ذَلِكَ الْكِتَابُ
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Here “*al-kitab*” or this book means the book which includes the special characteristics of all celestial books.

However the “al” in “هُوَ الْحَقُّ” (*huwal haqq*): that all specialties of its kind have been included in it.

- When something is meant to be referred in context to a particular person, “al” is used. For example “الْمَدِينَةُ” (*al-medina*): the city of Medina, The city of the Messenger. With this reference, that city became well known and famous.

Sometimes, it gives the meaning of “الَّذِي” (*al-lazi*), for instance “الضَّرِبُ” (*az-zaribu*), which is a person who beats or hits.

A-L-A أَلَا

This is a combination of *hamza* for questioning or enquiry, and *la* of denial.

Quran says:

24:22	Don't you desire that God should arrange your protection?	أَلَا تُحِبُّونَ أَنْ يَغْفِرَ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ
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Or:

9:13	Won't you wage war on those who have not kept their words (promises)?	أَلَا تَقَاتِلُونَ قَوْمًا نَكَثُوا أَيْمَانَهُمْ
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This is also a word of warning. It is also used to warn or assure somebody. For example:

2:12	Be warned that these (people) are <i>mufsideen</i>	أَلَا إِنَّهُمْ هُمُ الْمُفْسِدُونَ
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Or it is a fact that these people are *mufsideen*. Both have the same meaning.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning is for two things to mix and intermingle with each other.

“ألف” (*alf*): ‘one thousand’. Plural is “ألاف” (*alafun*) or “ألوف” (*ulufun*).

Since a thousand has four digits, “ألاف” (*al-ilfu*): co-ordination and being intertwined, or a companion who intermingles. (Or the word “ألف” (*alfun*) is from the word “ألف” (*ilfun*).

“ألف بينهم” (*al-lafa bainahoom*): “created co-ordination between them” Co-ordination similar to the intermingling that clouds make with each other.

24:43	Haven't you seen how Allah drives the clouds, adds them together and stacks them in piles?	أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ يَرْجِي سَحَابًا ثُمَّ يُؤَلِّفُ بَيْنَهُ
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“ألوف” (*al-mu'allifu*): something that is compiled.

“ألافه” (*al-ulfah*): to intermingle with each other.

“ألوفه قلوبهم” (*al-mu-allafat-o qulubuhum*): in whose hearts love and brotherhood needs to be kindled.

“ألافا” (*al-eelaaf*): to familiarize with and make friendly with.

106:1	Collaboration with Quresh	لَا يَلَابِ قُرَيْشٍ
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As such, it means mutual promises, the agreement which binds two parties together. These were the agreements between the **Quresh** and others so that the **Quresh** (a tribe of Mecca) caravans will not be looted as they were the keepers of Mecca.

About the **Momineen**, the Quran says:

3:103	you were each other's enemy, God created harmony between you and thus through His Benevolence you became brothers	إِذْ كُنْتُمْ أَعْدَاءَ فَأَلَّفَ بَيْنَ قُلُوبِكُمْ فَأَصْبَحْتُمْ بِنِعْمَتِهِ
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Hence the true meaning gets clarified from this. “أنتلاف” (*intilaaf*) is a step ahead of co-operation. With this, individuals intermingle with each other and a spirit of homogeneity prevails. If a society doesn't have such relationship between individuals, then that society does not comprise of **Monineen** or Believers. Co-operation and homogeneity is the natural outcome or essential result of **Imaan** (belief). When different persons have the same purpose in life, their destination is the same, the path is the same, and then why would not their hearts be intertwined as well?

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is to chew something in the mouth. A message is hence called “ألوكه” (*al-aluk*) because it is chewed out from the mouth.

Many people believe that this is the correct root for the word “مَلَايِكَةُ” (*malaika*) which according to them means “angel” or “messenger”, with respect to the meaning of “ألك” (*alak*) as delivering a message.

“ألكني ألى فلان” (*alikni ala falanin*): give him this message from me.

But other researchers think that its root is (**M-L-K**) which means strength and authority. **Raghib** thinks that “مَلَايِكَةُ” (*malaika*) is actually plural of “مَلَكٌ” (*malak*). Those angels, who are entrusted with administrative duties, are called “مَلَكٌ” *malak* and humans who do the planning are called “مَلِكٌ” (*malikun*).

Mufti Muhammad Abdohu writes in his explanation of the Quran, (*Al-Manar*) that it is a fact that everything has a strength (nucleus) on which the thing depends. Those who do not believe on **Wahi** (Revelation) they call it the “physical force” and in the Quranic language it is called “*malaikah*”. But call

it whatever you desire, the truth remains the same, and an intelligent person is one whom names do not prevent from getting to the truth.

Quran calls the “*malaika*” “messengers”.

22:75	Allah picks messengers from among the <i>malikah</i> and from among <i>ins</i> .	اللَّهُ يَصْطَلِي مِنَ الْمَلَائِكَةِ رُسُلًا وَمِنَ النَّاسِ
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But this (relaying messages) is only one of the duties of the *malaika*. Comprehensively, they have been called “مُدَبِّرَاتِ أَمْرٍ” (*mudabbiraateh amran*) 79:5 and “مُقَسِّمَاتِ أَسْرٍ” (*muqassimateh isran*) 51:4. In other words, they are forces or groups which plan and execute different chores. There are different forces at work in the universe as ordained by God. The forces which bring into practicality those schemes according to the laws of God have been called “*malaika*”.

This way the more probable root for “*malaika*” is M-L-K, instead of A-L-K.

These forces are not free to do what they want at their own will (God has granted this ability only to Man.) This is why these forces carry out God’s will without fail and without any questioning.

16:50	whatever is said to them, they carry out	وَيَفْعَلُونَ مَا يُؤْمَرُونَ
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The laws according to which these forces carry out their tasks have been made known to Man. In other words, Man has been enabled to find out about the laws of nature if he wants to. Therefore, these forces can be controlled by Man. This is what is meant by the “*malaika*” bowing before *Adam*. This is what is known as conquering Nature.

But “*malaika*” are not only the forces which act in the external affairs of this world; they also influence Man’s internal (psychological) life.

41:30	It is a fact that those who believe in the <i>raboobiya</i> (sustaining power) of God, and are steadfast in this belief, have <i>malaika</i> coming down to them saying ‘do not have fears or woe of any kind.’	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ قَالُوا رَبُّنَا اللَّهُ ثُمَّ اسْتَقَامُوا تَتَنَزَّلُ عَلَيْهِمُ الْمَلَائِكَةُ أَلَّا تَخَافُوا وَلَا تَحْزَنُوا
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Here, by coming down or “*nuzool*” means the psychological change that is produced within Man due to unshaken belief in God’s sustaining power. Contrary to this, forces which produce fear and hopelessness in Man, whether they are external or psychological, have been called the “*Shaitans*”.

These were the “*malaika*” which gave heart to the *mujahideen* in the fields of *Badr* and *Hunain* (8:12 and 9:16).

These are the forces which cause changes in Man’s body till death plays its part (4:97; 16:28). Besides, *malaika* are the also the “registrars” of human acts. In other words, they are responsible for the natural cause and effect of these acts (1(0:21; 43:80). These registers of acts have been referred as *malaika*, but at another place it has been mentioned that God himself also takes care of it (19:79); it has also been said that ‘Man hangs this “register of actions” around his neck’ (17:13; 14). Deliberating on these verses, one can easily understand that *malaika* are those celestial forces which create the result of everything according to God’s law of cause and effect and that result affects human personality.

Since *malaika* are meta-physical, they are invisible to the human eye (9:40; 9:26). As regarding the system by which *malaika* used to bring *wahi* (Revelation) to the Messengers, we cannot understand how it was done because that is beyond our comprehension. We are duty- bound to have faith in it and act according to it though the greatness and veracity of what has been revealed can be understood with knowledge. Not only *wahi*, but also how these forces work is also beyond our comprehension. We can only know what we feel or see. In other words, we can only understand so far as our senses allow us.

The Quran says one of the elements of belief (faith) is belief in **malaika** (2:285), meaning thereby that, in order to be a Muslim, one must believe in God, the [divinely-revealed] Books, the Messengers and the Day of Judgment along with belief in **malaika**. Now, what does belief in **malaika** mean? It means that one must have the same concept about them and to hold them in the same esteem (position) as the Quran has held for them.

About the **malaika** the Quran says that they bowed (performed **sajdah**) before Adam (4:43). As said before, Adam allegorically means the human race. Therefore, their bowing before Man means man can subjugate them (the forces). Keep the forces of Nature which we have not, as yet discovered or able to master to one side. Let us talk about the forces which have come to light so far. The correct belief would be that they are subservient to man.

Therefore, according to the Quran, the nation to whom these forces do not subjugate themselves are not fit to be in the human race itself leave alone **Momineen** (Believers) because believers are the best of the human race. This is a moment of reflection. A nation whose belief (part of its faith) is that these forces must bow before Man, are today themselves bowing before those forces, nay, even before those who have subjugated these forces. It is a dismal measure of their degradation.

Remember: Man's place is such that all forces of the universe must bow before him. And a **Momin's** place is to master these forces for the betterment of Mankind. A little thought is enough to make one realize that we Muslims in today's world don't even enjoy Man's honor, leave alone a **Momin's** honor.

A-L-L ا ل ل

Ibn Faris says it basically means 'to sparkle with movement', and also produce a sound at the same time.

“اِلَلّ” (**al-illa**): anything that should be honored and its rights fulfilled; for instance, relationships, pity, neighborliness, pact etc. anything so specified and concluded that it cannot be denied. The real meaning of this word is 'to sparkle'.

Besides that, it also means 'a reason which is protected'. “اِلِلّ” (**al-illu**): such things in society which are clear, distinct, and open and need no religion or criterion to be proven true; something that is true and respectable for all. For instance, good behavior with neighbors or relatives is an established norm in society and needs no proof.

The Quran says about the **Quresh** (the tribe to which the Messenger belonged):

6:8	They have gone so far in their opposition (that in your case) they do not even respect or observe the norms normally observed in society; nor do they respect any right being sanctimonious.	لَا يَرْفُقُوا فِيكُمْ إِلَّا وَلَا ذِمَّةً
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There was also an indication towards those about whom the Messenger had said:

42:23	I don't demand any compensation for relaying (God's) message to you, but you should not go so far in your opposition so as to ignore even the rights that ordinarily are due a relative	لَا أَسْأَلُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ أَجْرًا إِلَّا الْمَوَدَّةَ فِي الْقُرْبَىٰ
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It should be noted that he doesn't even demand this (right) as a payment for the message (of God). All Messengers never asked for compensation. They only drew attention to common social rights which should be respected.

This may also mean that if they were kind among themselves, it can be the return for the Messenger's being sent as a messenger because at another place it is said:

34:47	The return that I ask of you is for your own good.	مَا سَأَلْتُكُمْ مِنْ أَجْرٍ فَهُوَ لَكُمْ
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27:31	(the thing is that) you should not mutiny against me.	أَلَا تَعْلَمُونَ عَلَيَّ
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Sometimes it is preceded by a “لِ” (*laam*) and becomes “لِئَلَّا” (*li-alla*) which means “so that”

2:150	So that nobody has any argument or reasoning against you.	لِئَلَّا يَكُونَ لِلنَّاسِ عَلَيْكُمْ حُجَّةٌ
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Il-la

إِلَّا

“إِلَّا” (*Il-la*) ordinarily means ‘except’, ‘but for’, ‘other than’, etc. The following examples will explain:

Example 1:

The whole nation stood up, except Zaid.	قَامَ الْقَوْمُ إِلَّا زَيْدًا
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This means that Zaid is a part of the nation, but he did not stand up.

The Quran says:

2:249	Few among them drank from it.	فَشَرَبُوا مِنْهُ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا مِّنْهُمْ
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Example 2:

Everyone stood up but the donkey didn't.	قَامَ الْقَوْمُ إِلَّا حِمَارًا
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This means that the donkey is not included among the people of the nation. In other words, nation is one thing and the donkey another. This is contrary to the first example.

The Quran says:

2:34	Once we told the <i>malaika</i> to bow before <i>Adam</i> , then they all did so, but Iblees did not.	وَإِذْ قُلْنَا لِلْمَلَائِكَةِ اسْجُدُوا لِآدَمَ فَسَجَدُوا إِلَّا إِبْلِيسَ
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In other words, *Iblees* was something else besides the *malaika*. Hence he was not one of them. Ergo it means that all *malaika* except *Iblees* prostrated. The command towards *Iblees* gets clarified from other verses like 7:12.

Likewise, the Quran says

42:23	Tell them I demand no compensation for this invitation (to accept Islam): I only want you to respect my rights as your relative (or each other's rights.)	قُلْ لَا أَسْأَلُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ أَجْرًا إِلَّا الْمَوَدَّةَ فِي الْقُرْبَىٰ
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Surah *Yunus* says:

10:98	Then why wasn't there such a habitat that accepted peace, so its peace could be beneficial for it, except nation of <i>Yunus</i> ?	فَلَوْلَا كَانَتْ قَرْيَةٌ آمَنَتْ فَنَفَعَهَا إِيمَانُهَا إِلَّا قَوْمَ يُونُسَ
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Example 3: Sometimes it is used to mean “و” (*waw*). For instance, as the Quran says:

27:10 27:11	In front of Us, Our Messengers do not need to have any fear, and neither do those (people) who sometimes transgress and later exchange that evil with virtue.	لَا تَخَفْ إِنِّي لَا يَخَافُ لَدَيْ الْمُرْسَلِينَ إِلَّا مَن ظَلَمَ ثُمَّ بَدَّلَ حُسْنًا بَعْدَ سُوءٍ
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Example 4: The Quran says:

38:14	None (of the groups among them) was such that it did not deny the messengers	إِن كُلِّ إِلَّا كَذَّبَ الرُّسُلَ
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All of them denied the Messengers. All of them did so. In other words, “*in kullun illa*” means all of them.

Example 5: Sometimes, it is used to mean “if not”. For instance:

9:40	Even if you didn't help him, so what? It is a fact that God helped him.	إِلَّا تَنْصُرُوهُ فَقَدْ نَصَرَهُ اللَّهُ
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Example 6: *Mufti Abdohu* (and his dear disciple the late *Syed Rashid Raza*) have written in *Tafseer al Manar* (vol. 1, pp. 404-419) that whenever “*illa*” appears with God's will, then it means a total NO. As in:

87:6	When we teach you the Quran, you will forget nothing	سَتُفَرِّقُونَ فَلَا تَنْسَى
87:7	Absolutely. God so ordain.	إِلَّا مَا شَاءَ اللَّهُ

This has been supported by 18:76.

17:86	“if we wanted, we would have taken away what we have sent to you as Wahi	وَلَيْنَ شِئْنَا لَنُدْهَبَنَّ بِالَّذِي أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْكَ
17:87	Absolutely. This is your God's <i>rahma</i>	إِلَّا رَحْمَةً مِّن رَّبِّكَ

This makes it clear that it was never God's will that anything in the Quran would be unsafe.

Al-Manar also gives some other examples, such as:

11:108	(The Hell-dwellers) will live there as long as the skies and earth remain (and the Heaven-dwellers in Heaven). Nobody can get out of one to go to the other.	خَالِدِينَ فِيهَا مَا دَامَتِ السَّمَاوَاتُ وَالْأَرْضُ إِلَّا مَا شَاءَ رَبُّكَ عَطَاءٌ غَيْرُ مَجْذُوذٍ
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Al-lazi الَّذِي

“الَّذِي” (*al-lazi*): that one (maculine)
 “الَّذَانِ” (*al-lazaan*): those two (masculine)
 “الَّذِينَ” (*al-lazeena*): those more than two (masculine)
 “الَّتِي” (*al-taani*): those two (feminine)
 “الَّتَانِ” (*al-latee*): that one (feminine)
 “الَّتَيْنِ” (*al-lati*) or (*al-layee*): those two (feminine).

59:22	Allah is that one, except which there is no God	هُوَ اللَّهُ الَّذِي لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ
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A-L-M ا ل م

“الْم” (*alam*) and “الَيْمَة” (*ailama*): means “pain”. “الَيْم” (*aleem*): someone or something that inflicts pain, or is “painful”. “الَيْمُ الْعَذَابِ” (*aleemul azaab*) is ia pain that has reached its height.

The writer of Muheet says that the unpleasantness in life is called “الْم” (*alam*). The opposite is “لَذَّة” (*lazza*) i.e. enjoyment or pleasure. {M}

“الْوَمَة” (*alumaton*) also means meanness. {T}

The Quran mentions “الَيْمُ الْعَذَابِ” (*aleemul azaab*) at several places. It means the result of wrong human deeds, or the insulting destruction in this life.

Nooh (Noah) told his nation that if they rebel against the laws of God then:

11:26	I fear of a painful <i>azaab</i> (punishment) on you	إِنِّي أَخَافُ عَلَيْكُمْ عَذَابَ يَوْمِ الْيَمِّ
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They faced this punishment in the shape of a great flood which destroyed them.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says about the hypocrites (munafiqeen)

2:10	There will be a painful punishment for them.	وَلَهُمْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ
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Ibn Faris writes that it basically means ‘to accept someone’s subjugation’.

“إِلَهِ” (*aleha*), “إِلَيْهِ” (*ilaiheh*), “يَالَهُ” (*yalah*), mean “to seek some one’s refuge in distress”.

“إِلَيْهِ” (*aaleha*) also means “to be surprised”.

“إِلَهِ” (*aalaha*) or “يَالَهُ” (*yalah*): “to give refuge to someone in distress”, or “to take someone under one’s protection”. As such “إِلَهُ بِالْمَكَانِ” means “to live in some house peacefully”. {T}

Under these circumstances, “إِلَهُ” (*ilahun*) would mean “someone whose refuge may be sought in danger”, or “someone who can be requested to save one from difficulties and the concept of whose loftiness surprises one”. Some think that this word has been extracted from “لَاه يَلِيَهُ” (*laha yaleekeh*), which means “to be lofty in stature and be hidden from the naked eye” {T}.

Some others say that “إِلَهُ” (*alah*): “that person became a slave” and “إِلَاهَهُ” (*al-lahahu*): “he enslaved him”. From this come “تَالِيَهُ” (*taleehun*) or “تَعْبِيدُ” (*ta’beed*) which mean “to enslave”. Also from this we have “إِلَهُ” (*ilah*) which as a verb, turns into “مَالُوهُ” (*maaluhun*), as “*kitab*” and “*maktoob*”

This way, “إِلَهُ” (*ilah*) would mean ‘a being whose rules must be accepted and whose laws must be followed and obeyed’.

As such, when the *Pharoah* told *Moosa*:

26:29	If you accept someone else as your “ <i>ilah</i> ” then I will have you imprisoned	قَالَ لَئِنْ اتَّخَذْتَ إِلَهًا غَيْرِي لَأَجْعَلَنَّكَ مِنَ الْمَسْجُونِينَ
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Here “*ilah*” means someone who is in power.

In the same manner, it is said:

25:43	Have you wondered about the man who became subservient to his own desires(emotions)?	أَرَأَيْتَ مَنْ اتَّخَذَ إِلَهُهُ هَوَاهُ
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Similarly, about God it is said:

43:84	He is the One who is in the heights of the skies as well as the depths of the universe	وَهُوَ الَّذِي فِي السَّمَاءِ إِلَهُ وَفِي الْأَرْضِ إِلَهُ
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Or, the one who is the ruler of the skies as well as of this world.

So the word also means ‘the one with power’ or ‘one who rules’.

Since in pagan times, people worshipped the sun and the moon etc. as being powerful, therefore “إِلَاهَهُ” (*ilaaha*): the moon, while “إِلَاهَهُ” (*aalaha*): the sun. This way, anything which is worshipped is called “إِلَهُ” (*ilah*). Even the idols which are worshipped are called “إِلَهُ” (*ilah*).

There is a school of thought that says that Allah is a static word, which has not been derived from any other word, but others say that this word was actually “إِلَهُ+ال” (*al-ilah*) that gradually became “الله” (*Allah*) {T}

In the noble Quran, the word “*Allah*” has been used to describe the identity of Almighty. Therefore, Allah (the *Ilah* in the Quran) is that lofty being which is hidden from human eyes, but compared to whose Greatness human intellect and comprehension are quite disabled. He is the One who rules the entire universe and whose obedience is a must. And we can obey Him only as per His dictates which He has endowed us with through *wahi* (Revelation) and which is now capsuled safely in the Quran.

As such, “اتَّبِعُوا اللَّهَ” (*ati-ullaha*) would mean “follow Allah’s law”. In the same way, whatever takes place in the universe, takes place according to Allah’s law. The world of meta-physics and this world too (*alam amar, alameh khalq*) are ruled by this law. These laws have been made as He wished them to be, and they work under his control and authority. This is the “سُنَّةُ اللَّهِ” (*sunnatul Allah*), way of Allah which undergoes no changes. (The details can be seen under the heading (Sh-Y-A).

The Quran is the sum of Allah's attributes, Allah's laws, Allah's orders, Allah's Tact, Allah's guidance, etc. All His teachings have a central point which is His Oneness or "*wahdaniya*". That is to announce that nothing except God's rule is Supreme in the universe.

So far as His composition or form is concerned, that is beyond our grasp because we are all finite and no finite can comprehend the infinite. However, while remaining within our mental limits, we can have some idea about Him from His 99 attributes. According to the Quran, the correct Belief is that which is according to the requirements in the Quran. Those who believe in God according to their own interpretation are not Believers, as per the Quran. This is a very important point and must be clearly understood. "God worship" and "virtuous actions" is only right, if done according to the Quran and not according to what different people, nation or religion thinking.

A-L-W/Y أ ل و/ي

“أَلَا” (*ala*), “يَأْلُو” (*yaluh*), “أَلَاؤُا إِلَيَّ” (*uluwan wa ilayya*): to be short of, to delay, to be lackadaisical, to abstain:

3:117	these people will not delay in your detriment	لَا يَأْلُونَكُمْ خَبَالًا
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“أَلَايَةُ” means ‘to swear’

“إِلَاءَ” is ‘swear to abstain’ e.g. swear not to go near a woman {*T*}.

2:226	those people who for swear to go near their wives (forswear having sex with their wives)	نَسَاءَهُمْ مِنْ يُؤْلُونَ لِلَّذِينَ
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Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:22	And they should not forswear helping others.	وَلَا يَأْتَلِ أُولَآءِ
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From these examples it is clear that this forswearing is of a kind which is harmful to others.

Raghib says that is the characteristic (of such swearing or forswearing). “مَا أَلَوْتُهُ” means “I don’t have the capacity for it.”

Ibn-ul-Erabi says that it means “to be slack” as well as “to have the capacity and strength” or “to stop” as well “to endow”. That is why “أَلَوْ” (which is the plural): “strength” as well as “endowment” or “gift”.

The Quran says:

55:13	which might and strength of your Provider will you belie (which gift and benevolence will you belie)	فَيَأْيِ آلَاءِ رَبِّكُمَا تُكَذِّبَانِ
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At every place, the meaning according to the context will prevail.

Note: “أَلَاءَ” (*alo-o*) as singular as “أَلَوْ” (*uloo*) was not found anywhere else other than in *Tajul Uroos*. In other dictionaries, it has appeared as “إِلْيَ” (*ilya*), or “إِلْيُنْ” (*ilyun*), although the meaning is still endowment and strength (capacity).

Allama Hameedud Deen Farahi, while writing in his compilation *Ta’leefal Quran* page 11, says: Although “أَلَاءَ” (*ala-u*) is said to mean (with consensus) benevolence, its usage in the Quran and in Arabic poetry shows that this is not its meaning. Apparently it means “strange workings” for which the Persian word “miracle” can be used...

With reference to **Johri** he says that “أَلَاءَ” (*ala’a*) means the good qualities. He has presented many Arabic verses as proof of this.

It means “up to”, “towards”, “according to time”, and also “house”.

2:187	then you must fast until night and	الَّيْلِ إِلَى الصَّبَامِ أَتَمُّوا ثُمَّ
17:1	From <i>masjid haram</i> to <i>masjid aqsa</i>	الْأَقْصَى الْمَسْجِدِ إِلَى الْحَرَامِ الْمَسْجِدِ

One thing is notable in the above verse. Here the word “الَّيْلِ” means “till the beginning of night”, which means when the day ends and night begins. The night is not included.

But in regards to the guidance of *wudu* (ritual ablution), the Quran says:

5:6	up to your elbows	إِلَى الْمَرَافِقِ
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Here, the meaning is including the elbows. Hence this distinction should be noted.

It also means “with”. For instance,

4:2	and don't devour (usurp) their wealth by mixing it with your own	أَمْوَالِكُمْ إِلَى أَمْوَالِهِمْ تَتَكَلَّمُوا وَلَا
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It also appears in the meaning of ‘for me, before me’. Like:

12:33	He said: O my Sustainer, jail is much better than what they draw me to.	قَالَ رَبِّ السِّجْنُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا يَدْعُونِي إِلَيْهِ
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It is also used to mean: “it is for him”

27:33	and it is for you to take the final decision	إِلَيْكَ
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Sometimes, it is also used to have the meaning of (*ala*) which means to talk against someone.

17:4	And we had decided this against the <i>Bani Israel</i>	وَقَضَيْنَا إِلَى بَنِي إِسْرَائِيلَ
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But it could also mean “We had informed the *Bani Israel* about it. In the latter case, (*ila*) would not be used in the meaning of (*ala*) but it would mean “towards it”. The word is commonly used in this sense.

Sometimes it is also used to mean “in,” for example:

4:87 6:12	He will collect you (all) on the day of <i>qayama</i>	لَيَجْمَعَنَّكُمْ إِلَى يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ
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Sometimes, it is also used in the sense of *minn*, meaning “from”. But such an example is not to be found in the Quran.

He has been discussed by the Quran as a messenger:

6:85	And Zikriyya, Yahya and Isa and Ilyas . All these were the righteous people	وَزَكَرِيَّا وَيَحْيَىٰ وَعِيسَىٰ وَإِلْيَاسَ كُلٌّ مِّنَ الصَّالِحِينَ
37:123	And indeed, Ilyas was one of the messengers.	وَإِنَّ إِلْيَاسَ لَمِنَ الْمُرْسَلِينَ

In the same surah he has been called “*il yaseen*”

37:130	Peace be upon il yaseen	سَلَامٌ عَلَىٰ إِلْيَاسِينَ
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It has been said that the nation towards which it was sent used to worship “*Ba-al*”.

37:125	Do you worship Ba-al ?	أَتَدْعُونَ بَعْلًا
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He is probably the same Messenger as **Elijah** in the Torah. Some others think that **Ilyas** is another name for messenger **Idrees**.

But (as it is mentioned under the heading **Idrees**) if **Idrees** was among the forefathers of **Nooh**, then **Ilyas** couldn't be **Idrees**.

Because in verse 6:85, **Ilyas** has been told to be from **Nooh's** (or **Ibrahim's**) progeny, hence he was probably one of the **Bani Israel's** Messengers.

This is another name for **Ilyas**. For details, see heading “**Ilyas**”. The Quran uses this name for him in 37:130.

This is the same Messenger as “**Elisha**” in the Torah. The Quran, while mentioning him as a messenger in 6:87, has said in 6:90 that they were all given the Book. Besides, he has been mentioned by name in 38:49. Detailed introduction is not given.

It means “or”. At times, it is used for a rhetorical question and, at others, as superfluous. The following examples will make it clear:

79:27	Is it more difficult to create you or the celestial bodies?	أَأَنتُمْ أَشَدُّ خَلْقًا أَمْ السَّمَاءُ بَنَاهَا
2:6	It is the same for them, whether you warn them or not.	سَوَاءٌ عَلَيْهِمْ أَأَنذَرْتَهُمْ
13:16	Ask them whether a blind man and one who can see are equal (or rather) can darkness and light be equal?	قُلْ هَلْ يَسْتَوِي الْأَعْمَىٰ وَالْبَصِيرُ أَمْ هَلْ تَسْتَوِي الظُّلُمَاتُ وَالنُّورُ
43:52	I am better than this (Am I not better than this?)	أَمْ أَنَا خَيْرٌ مِّنْ هَٰذَا الَّذِي
18:9	Do you know that the men of the cave and those with the tablets were from among our strange signs	أَمْ حَسِبْتَ أَنَّ أَصْحَابَ الْكَهْفِ وَالرُّقُمِ كَانُوا مِنِ آيَاتِنَا عَجَبًا

Ibn Faris says it means something which is slim at one end and thick at the other.

“أَمَتَ” (*amat*), “يَأْمِتُ” (*ya-mit*), “أَمْتًا” (*umta*) mean “to estimate, to assess”.

“أَمَاتَهُ أَمْتًا” (*amatahu amta*): “he intended (to do) this”.

“أَلَأْمَتُ” (*al-amt*): “small dunes, vicissitude, height and depth” {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

20:107	Without waves or being uneven	لَا تَرَى فِيهَا عِوَجًا وَلَا أَمْتًا
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“أَمْتًا” (*amtha*) is the opposite of clean and even. It is also used to mean “to oppose” and also “doubt”.

As such, it is said “الْخَمْرُ حُرْمَتٌ لِأَمْتٍ فِيهَا” (*al-hamru hurman la amta fiha*): Intoxication has been declared as *haram* (forbidden). There is no doubt about it.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is “being extreme”.

“أَمَدٌ” (*amad*): ‘a period (of time)’.

Raghib says that “أَمَدٌ” (*amad*) and *abad* are close in meaning as *abad* is used for an unlimited period of time and “أَمَدٌ” (*amad*) has to have an ending.

“زَمَانٌ” (*zaman*) “time” is used for the beginning or ending or both, of time, but “أَمَدٌ” (*amad*) is used only for the last (or extreme) limit of time. {*T, M, R*}

“أَلْأَمَدُ” (*al-amad*): ‘the extreme end of life’.

The Quran says:

3:29	he would want a long period of time between him and the Day of the Judgment	تَوَدُّ لَوْ أَنَّ بَيْنَهَا وَبَيْنَهُ أَمَدًا بَعِيدًا
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The compiler of **Muheet** says that in this verse “أَمَدٌ” (*amad*): distance.

In 72:25 the word has been used against closeness, where it has been said:

72:25	Tell them I do not know whether what I promise you (the Day) is near or whether my Sustainer will extend the period.	قُلْ إِنْ أَدْرِي أَقْرَبُ مِمَّا تُوعَدُونَ أَمْ يَجْعَلُ لَهُ رَبِّي أَمَدًا
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As such, it would mean “a long time”.

“أَمْرٌ” (*amr*): ‘order, situation, matter, work,’ etc. {F}

Ibn Faris also includes “mark” among its basic meanings.

“الْأَمْرَةُ وَالْأَمْرُ” (*al-amrat-o wat'tamoor*): A sign made of small stones in the desert to mark boundaries or a path. As such, it basically means a mark, a sign, indication pointing towards a way. From this, it has come to mean ‘consult’.

“الْأَتْمَارُ” (*al-atimaar*) means “to discuss”, “to seek advice”.

Surah *Airaaf* says that the Pharoah discussed the matter of Musa (Moses) with his officials and said:

7:110	So, what do you suggest?	فَمَاذَا تَأْمُرُونَ
26:35	So, what do you suggest?	فَمَاذَا تَأْمُرُونَ
65:6	Consult each other	وَأْتَمِرُوا بَيْنَكُمْ

Similarly, surah *Al-Qasas* says that a man came running from the opposite direction and said to Musa:

28:20	The chiefs are discussing among themselves about murdering you.	إِنَّ الْمَلَأَ يَأْتَمِرُونَ بِكَ لِيَقْتُلُوكَ
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But *Tajul Uroos* says that here it means ‘to firmly decide’. These days this word means “conference”.

“أَمِيرٌ” (*ameer*) is the person whose advice is sought. One who leads the blind is also called the same.

“أَمْرٌ” (*amar*): for something to become more than needed.

“أَمْرُ الرَّجُلِ” (*amir rajul*): “that man’s animals became too many (proliferated)”

“الْأَمِيرُ” (*al-amir*): a man with proliferation.

Ibn Faris says that with this meaning, where in surah *Bani Israel* it says *amirna mutrafeeha* in 17:16, it means “We proliferate wealth for the *mutrafeen*”. But I think that it means that God’s law in regard to destruction of nations is that such nations become prone to a life of luxury, demand abundance, lazy and of capitalist mentality. There is increase of well-to-do people who create imbalances in society and thus destroy the nation or cause its deterioration.

Where it means an order, the plural is “أَوْمِرٌ” (*awamir*), (*awamir*) and (*nawahi*), where *awamir* is the opposite of *nahi* and where it means matter, situation, or accident, or event, then the plural is “أُمُورٌ” (*umoor*), but word “أَوْمِرٌ” (*awamir*) appears nowhere in the Quran.

According to these meanings, “الْأَمِيرُ” (*al-ameer*) would mean a ruler.

2:67	Allah orders you	إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُكُمْ
24:62	On a collective matter.	عَلَى أَمْرٍ جَامِعٍ

“الْإِمْرَةُ” (*al-imratu*): government. {T}

“إِمَارَةٌ” (*imaratu*) also means the same, that is, government.

“أَمْرٌ عَظِيمٌ” (*amrun azeem*): great incident. {T}

16:33	a decisive stage	أَوْ يَأْتِيَ أَمْرٌ رَبَّكَ
18:71	a very obnoxious thing	جِئْتُ شَيْئًا إِمْرًا

“الْأَمْرَةُ” (*al-ammarah*) is one who orders a lot, one who disturbs a lot.

12:33	Opinion, willingness, wish	مَا أَمُرُّهُ
18:82	I didn’t do it willingly	وَمَا فَعَلْتُهُ عَنْ أَمْرِي

The Quran uses “أَمْرٌ” (*amar*) as against “خَلْقٌ” (*khalq*) or creation in 7:54.

And it has a special meaning to comprehend while its root has to be kept in mind i.e. sign, symbol, leading the way.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is also ‘to nurture’.

As it has been mentioned under the heading (*Kh-L-Q*), “خَلْقٌ” (*khalq*) also means “to create new things in new ways”.

“خَلْقٌ” (*khalq*) is that stage of birth (or creation) when we can feel or sense those things, but obviously there is a stage before this stage as well.

That is when these things are in the process of becoming. This planning stage is about the world of “أَمْرٌ” (*amar*).

One other thing must be noted here. The universe has many things, such as the sun, the moon, the stars, the trees etc. Then there is an order in the universe according to which these things operate. This law or order is also called “*amar*”. A detailed explanation will be found under the heading (*Sh-Y-A*).

About the planning situation the Quran says:

2:117	when he decides about some planning “ <i>amar</i> ” then He tells the “ <i>amar</i> ” to be and it happens	وَإِذَا قَضَىٰ أَمْرًا فَإِنَّمَا يَقُولُ لَهُ كُنْ فَيَكُونُ
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What this “أَمْرٌ” (*amar*) is and how it is formulated, we are not able to say.

Our knowledge is confined to a sensory world only, and these things are beyond their purview. The famous philosopher and thinker Pringle Patterson acknowledges that it is a shortcoming of the English language that it has only one word for “*takhleeq*” and that is “creation.” Although the physical world’s creation and the meta-physical world’s creation demanded that there should have been two separate words, but no. Quran has done this and used two different words, the words of “*khalq*” and “*amar*”, respectively.

The other part of “أَمْرٌ” (*amar*) i.e. the law or God’s order, which is operative in the universe, is before us and can be known about (in fact, we do know about many scientific facts). But only so far as to know how the law works in certain cases. Why any law is the way as it is, we are unable to say. For instance, we know that water flows towards the slope, that is the scientific fact or the law, and we know this, but we don’t know why this law has been made for water!

The Quran is full of such “*amar*” i.e. the laws of God:

7:54	the sun, the moon, the stars, are all bound in God’s law or follow God’s law	وَالشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ وَالنُّجُومُ مُسَخَّرَاتٌ بِأَمْرِهِ
22:65	ships sail on the seas according to His law	وَالْفُلُوكَ يَجْرِي فِي الْبَحْرِ بِأَمْرِهِ

In vers 34:12 “*izn*” and “*amar*” have been used in homogenous meanings. See heading “*Izn*”.

The Quran says that just as in the physical world, everything works according to a particular law, and every result is subject to a particular order. In the same way, in the social world of humans too, the destruction and rise and fall of a nation also take place according to a law. This is the ‘law of consequences’ or ‘result of actions’, and this too has been called “*amar*”

8:42	So Allah decided the matter in the way it got settled, so the fallen one fell, and the survivor survived.	لَيَقْضِيَنَّ اللَّهُ أَمْرًا كَانَ مَفْعُولًا لِّبَيْتِكَ مَنْ هَلَكَ عَنْ بَيِّنَةٍ وَيَحْيَىٰ مَنْ حَيَّ عَنْ بَيِّنَةٍ
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Meaning thereby that whosoever has to be destroyed will be destroyed according to a law and whoso-ever has to live will do so according to the law. This is the law of consequence in whose result Man can do nothing.

Not even a *rasul* or Messenger can make any changes in this law:

3:127	O rasul, you have no intervention in this law	لَيْسَ لَكَ مِنَ الْأَمْرِ شَيْءٌ
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This “*amar*” or law is about human actions and is given to Messengers through the knowledge revealed to them and through them to the other human beings:

45:17	We have told them the clear things about <i>amar</i> .	وَأَتَيْنَاهُمُ بَيِّنَاتٍ مِّنَ الْأَمْرِ
65:5	this is Allah’s <i>amar</i> or law which He has revealed to you	ذَلِكَ أَمْرُ اللَّهِ أَنزَلَهُ إِلَيْكُمْ

Thus Allah’s “أَمْرٌ” (*amr*) has three stages, one where every law is fixed and everything is planned. We cannot find out about this stage. The second niche of God’s *amar* or law is manifest in the universe and the knowledge about it can be gained through experiment, intellect, observation and insight. The third niche is that which deals with humans. This is granted to Messengers through *Wahi* (Revelation) and through them to other humans. It is preserved in the Quran and according to which the life or death of nations is decided. Every human can climb the evolutionary stages of life in accordance with its understanding.

In the first niche, Allah makes and operates the laws as He wishes. In the second niche, He operates the universe according to the laws framed by Him and the things in the universe are bound to follow His laws. In the third niche, His laws are given to Mankind through *Wahi* but they are given the choice to accept them or not, as they wish. But whatever path a man chooses will result accordingly. Allah’s decisions, be they about the universe or about human life, are not subject to any change. This too is God’s decision.

A-M-S ا م س

“أَمْسٌ” (*ams*) or “الْأَمْسُ” (*al-ams*): ‘yesterday’. In surah *Qasas*, it has been used in this very meaning

28:18	the man who asked him for help, yesterday	فَإِذَا الَّذِي اسْتَنْصَرَهُ بِالْأَمْسِ
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But as is meant by “those who asked him for help till yesterday...” doesn’t really mean the past day, but it means till some days back.

“الْأَمْسُ” (*al-ams*) is also used in this sense. In the same surah, a little ahead, it is said:

28:82	The people who till yesterday wished to attain that position (<i>Qaroon’s</i>)....	وَأَصْبَحَ الَّذِينَ تَمَنَّوْا مَكَانَهُ بِالْأَمْسِ
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A-M-L ا م ل

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is ‘to wait for something or somebody, and ‘have a doubtful expectation or hope’. To hopefully wait for a result that is expected but is late.

“أَمَلٌ” (*al-aml*): expectation or hope, hence used for expectation of something not very probable. As such, a person who wishes to travel to a distant place will use “أَمَلْتُ” (*amalto*), but if the place is nearby and it is easy to go there, then he will use “طَمَعْتُ” (*ta-meto*). This shows the difference between these two words. {M}. The word “رَجَاءٌ” (*rajao*) is used with regards to both. {T}

“أَلَامِيلٌ” (*al-ameel*) is a sand dune which is a day’s travel away.
 “تَأَمَّلَ الرَّجُلُ” (*ta ammala rajul*): to wait and think about a matter.

Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

15:3	Their extended wishes (hopes) keeps them away from the real purpose of life.	وَيَمْتَنِعُوا وَيُلْهِهِمُ الْأَمَلُ
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A-M-M

ا م م

Ibn Faris says that this root has four basic meanings:

- Fundament
- Junction
- Group
- Deen (system of life).

“أُمُّ” (*um*) is that syllable which a child utters before learning to speak, according to **Muheet**’s compiler which leads to its meaning as ‘mother’. Some also call “أُمُّ” (*um*) as “أُمَّةٌ” (*ummah*) and some even call “أُمِّيَّةٌ” (*ummya*) whose plural is “أُمَّهَاتٌ” (*ummahaat*). As regards to a mother’s lap, a man’s abode is also called “أُمُّ” (*um*).

A nation is also called “أُمَّةٌ” (*ummah*), specially the one of similar sect or group.

Surah *Al-Baqra* after mentioning various things about the Messengers says:

2:134	It was an <i>umma</i> (nation) which has passed (is no more).	بَلْكَ أُمَّةٌ قَدْ خَلَتْ
21:92	Surely your nation is unique.	إِنَّ هَذِهِ أُمَّتُكُمْ أُمَّةً وَاحِدَةً

Besides this, its meaning is of being the base or fundament of something.

“أُمُّ الْقَوْمِ” (*ummul qaum*): the chief of his nation.

“أُمُّ النُّجُومِ” (*ummul nujum*): galaxy.

“أُمُّ الرَّأْسِ” (*ummur raas*): the mind.

“أُمُّ” (*um*) is also used to describe the point or junction where all things meet. In this regard Mecca is called “أُمُّ الْقُرَى” (*ummul Qura*).

“أُمُّ الْكِتَابِ” (*ummul kitab*): the basis of law. {T}

“أَلْأُمَّةُ” (*al-ummah*): condition, gift, grandeur, time, period, *sharia* (the laws of life according to Islam) and deen.

This word has appeared as meaning period of time in following verse:

12:45	The one, who had been released, said after thinking a period	وَقَالَ الَّذِي نَجَا مِنْهُمَا وَادَّكَرَ بَعْدَ أُمَّةٍ
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It also means “إِمَامٌ” (*imam*) meaning leader and “هَادِيٌ” (*hadi*), meaning one who shows the right path.

As **Abu Obaidah** has said in his translation:

16:120	Indeed, Abraham was a humble leader	إِنَّ إِبْرَاهِيمَ كَانَ أُمَّةً قَانِتًا
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Here the word *imam* would mean leader, as well as follower. Although it might also mean that Ibrahim was an individual, he was so complete as if to encompass an entire nation.

“أُمَّةٌ” (*ummat*), “فُعْلَةٌ” (*fu’lat*) or “فُعْلَةٌ” (*fu’alaht*), “فُعْلَةٌ” (*fu’la*) means something which is much intended. It may therefore mean the leader.

“فُعْلَةٌ” (*fu’ala*): he who thinks a lot about someone. As such with this meaning, “” (*ummah*) in 16:120 would mean one who turns to God time and again.

Ibn Qateebah has written that “أُمَّةٌ” (*ummah*), means “way of life, leader or group”.

Lataiful Lughaat (a dictionary) also says that it means “a man who has all the best traits”, and it also means “*Imam*”. For more details see **Tatammah** vol.VI pub 1812.

”إِمَامَةً“ (*al imama*): to be in front, to lead.

”إِمَامٌ“ (*imam*) is the person who is in front, that is, in leadership. It also means a man who is the embodiment and fountainhead of all types of goodness. At another place the Quran verifies the meaning:

2:124	Indeed, I am the one to have appointed you to be a leader to the mankind.	إِنِّي جَاعِلُكَ لِلنَّاسِ إِمَامًا
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This is also the name of the thread or string which masons use to determine whether all bricks are laid in a straight line or not. In Arabic, the instrument for doing this is called *faadin* and in Urdu, *sahil*. Besides, a wide street is also called ”إِمَامٌ“ (*imam*). 15:79

”أَمَامٌ“ (*amam*): of being in front, future. For example:

75:5	Mankind will continue to live in evil	بَلْ يُرِيدُ الْإِنْسَانُ لِيَفْجُرَ أَمَامَهُ
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”أَمَةً“ (*amahu*), ”يَوْمَهُ“ (*yau-umo-hu*), ”أَمًا“ (*amma*): ‘to decide to, to be of the intent’.

”أَمِينَ“ (*ammeen*): those who intend to, those who decide to. Quran uses ”*amma*” and all its derivatives, which appear above in all the meanings given above. As such, there is no need for examples.

”أُمِّي“ (*al-ummi*) is one word whose meanings must be understood correctly. It basically means one who is in the state of his birth (to stay as innocent as at the time of birth) and who doesn’t learn to read or write. {L}

Our messenger *Muhammad* is also called ”أُمِّي“ (*ummi*) because he didn’t know how to read or write. But this is before his Messenger-hood. He had learnt to read and write after being endowed with Messenger-hood. There is distinct evidence to that effect in the Quran.

Surah *Al-Ankabut* says:

29:48	(Before the revelation of the Quran) you did not read nor write this with your hand.	وَمَا كُنْتَ تَتْلُو مِنْ قَبْلِهِ مِنْ كِتَابٍ وَلَا تَخُطُّهُ بِيَمِينِكَ
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From this, it is evident that before revelation of the Quran he did not read or write but this condition changed after revelation. That is why the Quran explained ”*min qiblehi*” (before this). But in the Quran, even the common Arabs have been called ”أُمِّي“ (*ummi*). This means the people who were not given any Code before the Quran because, this word has appeared against ”*ahley kitab*” that is, those with the Code.

See 3:19 and 3:74. The *Christians* and the Jews were called ”those with the Code” in the Arab world, and those who didn’t claim to have any celestial Book or Code, were called ”*ghair ahley kitab*” that is, those without a Book or ”*ummi*”. This doesn’t mean that they were completely illiterate.

This was only a figure of speech for the ”*ahley kitab*” to distinguish them from others. Thus at several places in the Quran ”أُمِّي“ (*ummi*): illiterate and at other places ”those people without any celestial Code.”

Besides this, ”أُمِّي“ (*ummi*) also means an inhabitant of Mecca ”أُمُّ الْقُرَى“ (*ummul Qura*). Like an inhabitant of *Hazarmaut* is called a *Hazarmi*.

Note: *Amma* is a letter which has been kept separate.

It may be kept in mind that the Quran has called Muslims who have been given this Book of Quran):

74:31	but only those who have the right knowledge of this Book	الَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْكِتَابَ
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Ilah is used only for God. All his other names are based on some trait or the other.

This word is used in sense of:

- as far as this is concerned
- so far as this thing is concerned

Example 1.

2:26	So far as the Believers are concerned, they know that...	فَأَمَّا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا فَيَعْلَمُونَ
80:5	as far as he who considers himself an exception	أَمَّا مَنْ اسْتَعْتَى
18:79	So far as the boat is concerned....	أَمَّا السَّفِينَةُ
18:80	And as far as the boy is concerned	وَأَمَّا الْغُلَامُ

Example 2.

Sometimes, **amma** means “or the thing that” or which. This is that very um which appears after a questioning **hamza**, for instance, as in surah **Anaam**:

6:144	Tell them that both males are made haram (forbidden) or both females, or that which is in their wombs.	قُلْ الذَّكَرَيْنِ حَرَّمَ أَمَّا الْأُنثَيَيْنِ أَمَّا اشْتَمَلَتْ عَلَيْهِ أَرْحَامُ الْأُنثَيَيْنِ
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Ibn Faris says its basic meaning are:

- The opposite of being dishonest for breaking someone's trust
- Peace and safety
- To verify

“أَمْنٌ” (**aman**): fearlessness, solace, to be protected from any fear.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** and Surah **Al-An'am** says:

2:240	When you are safe	فَإِذَا أَمِنْتُمْ
6:81	so which group among these two deserves security the most	فَأَيُّ الْفَرِيقَيْنِ أَحَقُّ بِالْأَمْنِ

“أَمْنٌ” (**aman**): to free somebody of worries and unease, to give peace to somebody, to take the responsibility of protecting someone.

“إِئْتِمَانٌ” (**itemaan**): to trust someone, or to make someone trustworthy.

“نَاقَةُ آمُونٍ” (**naqatun amoon**) is a female camel which is pretty strong, as such its limbs and habits are trust worthy. Something one can be sure about, that with continuous use, it will not weaken and not stumble and fall on the way.

“مُؤْمِنٌ” (**momin**) is someone who guarantees peace, one on whom a person can depend with equanimity, the guarantor of world peace.

“أَمَانَةٌ” (**amanat**) is something which is kept in trust {M}

“حَمَلَ أَمَانَةً” (**hamal amanat**) means to break the trust of **amanat** (see heading H-M-L).

“أَمِينٌ” (**ameen**) is someone without fear, as regards one's safety or trust. One who is dependable.

“بَلَدٌ أَمِينٌ” (**baladun amen**) is the city which has peace and security (95:3)

“مَقَامٌ أَمِينٌ” (**maqamun amen**) the place where there is complete contentment (in the above meaning) and security (44:52) {L}

The Quran says:

26:162	I am the Messenger of peace for you	إِنِّي لَكُمْ رَسُولٌ أَمِينٌ
16:112	Allah narrates the tale of a dwelling which was content and in peace. It had the accoutrements of life coming in from other places in plenty. Then it did not appreciate Allah's benevolence. So Allah made them taste the punishment of hunger and fear.	وَضَرَبَ اللَّهُ مَثَلًا قَرْيَةً كَانَتْ آمِنَةً مُطْمَئِنَّةً يَأْتِيهَا رِزْقُهَا رَغَدًا مِّنْ كُلِّ مَكَانٍ فَكَفَرَتْ بِأَنْعُمِ اللَّهِ فَأَذَاقَهَا اللَّهُ لِبَاسَ الْجُوعِ وَالْخَوْفِ بِمَا كَانُوا يَصْنَعُونَ
15:82	For security, they used to carve out mountains to make houses	وَكَانُوا يَنْحِتُونَ مِنَ الْجِبَالِ بُيُوتًا آمِنِينَ
3:154	then he endowed you with peace after sorrow.	ثُمَّ أُنْزِلَ عَلَيْكُمْ مِّنْ بَعْدِ الْغَمِّ أَمْنَةٌ

Here “أَمْنٌ” (*aman*) has come as the opposite of sorrow.

The Quran has used this word's root to mean trust at various places.

2:283	if one of you trust the other	فَإِنْ أَمِنَ بَعْضُكُم بَعْضًا
12:11	then he doesn't trust us	لَا تَأْمَنَّا
12:17	And you will not believe us	وَمَا أَنْتَ بِمُؤْمِنٍ لَّنَا
12:64	He said that I do not trust you like I trusted you	قَالَ هَلْ أَمْنُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا كَمَا أَمْسِكُمْ

At all these places the word *Amn* has been used to mean trust, and belief.

“أَمْنٌ” (*aman*) also means to accept (agree).

Regarding the Bani Israel, surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:55	we will not agree upon what you say	لَنْ نُّؤْمِنَ لَكَ
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This has the connotation of trustworthiness, belief and obedience, all together. When ب (*beh*) comes after it, then it means to trust upon it.

2:285	All trusted upon Allah	كُلٌّ أَمِنَ بِاللَّهِ
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“أَمْنٌ” (*aman*) therefore means:

- To trust
- To accept, or not deny
- To certify, to agree of something being the truth, not to deny it.
- To trust and be secure about something
- To accept, to obey, to bow one's head in acceptance.

There are five basic facts on which one must trust, that is, have *Iman*, which makes one Momin.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:177	Open is the path for him who has trust in God, on the time of judgement, on the <i>malaikah</i> , on the Book (the Quran) and the Messengers	وَلِكِنَّ الْبِرَّ مَنْ آمَنَ بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةِ وَالْكِتَابِ وَالنَّبِيِّينَ
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Denying any one of the above mentioned is *kufr*.

4:136	One who denies Allah, and his <i>malaikah</i> , This Book, Messengers and the time of the Judgement, goes far in denial.	وَمَنْ يَكْفُرْ بِاللَّهِ وَمَلَائِكَتِهِ وَكُتُبِهِ وَرُسُلِهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَقَدْ ضَلَّ ضَالًّا بَعِيدًا
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Belief or **Eemaan** on Allah means to have total faith in Him, to believe whatever he says, belief in all His laws, and to agree to obey them. To believe in the time of Judgement means to have complete faith in the laws of cause and effect (in human affairs as well), and belief in Life after Death. Belief on the **malaikah** means to have faith that these celestial forces are engaged in carrying out God's program in the universe and God has subjugated them before Man.

He has conquered them for Man. Therefore, there is no force among them for Man to bow to. Faith on the Messenger means that Man's intellect alone is not enough to go through life successfully. The guidance for this comes through **Wahi**, and **Wahi** does not come direct, but through selected individuals who are called Messengers. This **Wahi** system ended with Messenger **Muhammed**. Faith on the Books means that this way of life has been received through **Wahi** and by following it Man can reach his ultimate destination. There is no other way through which one can reach the destination. To act according to this Book is an active display of faith on the Messenger (**peace be upon him**). But after the revelation of the Quran, no other book can be Man's beacon of light for a successful life.

As such, a Momin is one who believes unshakably the laws of God which are at play in the universe and the laws that have been given to us through **Muhammad**, and is now preserved in the Quran. Belief on the results of all human acts (in this world as well as in the Hereafter).

A group consisting of such persons as having these beliefs have been called by the Quran as “يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا” (**ya ayyohal lazeena amenu**), but warns at the same time lest only the name remains and the spirit is not there. To ensure that they remain so, they were told that like the others, the rest of humanity (the Christians and the Jews) they too, must have faith in the laws of God and on repayment (of human deeds).

They can have a fearless and content life only in this way, and not simply by being born into a Muslim family:

2:62	Verily those who call themselves the Momins, and those who are the Christians, the Jews and the sabiens whosoever will entrust on Allah and do good deeds, will have their repayment with their Sustainer, and they will have no woe nor fear	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَالَّذِينَ هَادُوا وَالنَّصَارَى وَالصَّابِئِينَ مَنْ آمَنَ بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ وَعَمِلَ صَالِحًا فَلَهُمْ أَجْرُهُمْ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِمْ وَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ
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Also see 4:136.

Along with this, God also said that the Christians and the Jews must not think that since they already believe in God and Life after Death, they do not need to have renewed trust in order to become **Momin**.

They were told clearly that until they believe in all matters as the Quran has laid out, nobody's belief will be called true belief:

2:137	if they trust the way you do, then they will be considered to be on the right path	فَإِنْ آمَنُوا بِمِثْلِ مَا آمَنْتُمْ بِهِ فَقَدْ اهْتَدَوْا
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Eeman is that belief which is according to the Quran and good deeds are also only those which are as the Quran has ordained.

Quran also says that there are people who do believe that God is the creator of the universe and the universe runs according to His laws, but they do not think it necessary to follow God's dictates in their matters (matters of human life) as laid out in the **Wahi** (God's message through the Messenger). Such people, according to the Quran are not true **Momin**. To be a true **moumin**, it is necessary for one to believe in God, and at the same time to believe in the **Wahi** and to lead one's life according to it.

For details see 23:82 to 90.

Also remember, that either due to some exigency, or since the **Momins** are in power, it is not **Eeman** to have faith. **Eeman** means to have faith in the lordship and truths of God from the core of the heart.

Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

49:14	Arabs say they have accepted <i>eeman</i> . Tell them they haven't. Say that you have accepted our subjugation, because <i>eeman</i> has not yet entered your hearts.	قَالَتِ الْأَعْرَابُ آمَنَّا قُلْ لَمْ تُؤْمِنُوا وَلَكِنْ قُولُوا أَسْلَمْنَا وَلَمَّا يَدْخُلِ الْإِيمَانُ فِي قُلُوبِكُمْ
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It must be clearly understood that *eeman* does not only mean acknowledging these facts, it also means to act accordingly.

Surah Rome says:

30:53	You can only recite (make them understand the Quran) only to those people who believe our orders and are subservient to them	إِنْ تُسْمِعْ إِلَّا مَنْ يُؤْمِنُ بِآيَاتِنَا فَهُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ
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This is why *eeman* has been treated as the opposite of *kufir* as in verse 2:3-6. It has also been made out as the opposite of (making inroads into) avoiding *Imaan*:

3:110	they are also the opposites of wrongdoers	مَنْهُمْ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَأَكْثَرُهُمُ الْفَاسِقُونَ
3:166	So that he can find out who are Momin	وَلِيَعْلَمَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ
3:167	and who are hypocrites	وَلِيَعْلَمَ الَّذِينَ نَافَقُوا

Quran calls God as Al-momin in 59:23, because He is the Protector of the entire universe. And whosoever believes on his laws is protected by Him from destructive forces. This way an individual is a *momin* when the entire human race can trust him and who is responsible for keeping peace.

From the above deposition, it can be well understood as to what a *momin* is, hat his place in society is and what his duties and responsibilities are.

Imma أَمَّا

“*imma*” (إِمَّا): either, or whether, and can be explained with the following examples:

9:106	Whether he punish them, or whether He listens to them.	إِمَّا يُعَذِّبُهُمْ وَإِمَّا يَتُوبُ عَلَيْهِمْ
20:65	They said, O <i>Moosa</i> , would you rather go first, or shall we do?	قَالُوا يَا مُوسَى إِمَّا أَنْ تُلْقِيَ وَإِمَّا أَنْ نَكُونَ أَوَّلَ مَنْ أَلْقَى

Sometimes it gives the meaning of condition. In that case the sentence also contains “*ma*”:

19:26	Then, if you see any person.....	فَإِمَّا تَرَيَنَّ مِنَ الْبَشَرِ أَحَدًا
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A-M-W ا م و

“*amah*” (أَمَةٌ): a slave girl. It is the opposite of “*hurrah*” (حُرَّةٌ) which is used for a free woman. Actually this word was “*amawuh*” (أَمَوَةٌ) or “*amwah*” (أَمَوَةٌ) {*T*}. Quran uses the word “*abd*” (عَبْدٌ) for the masculine and “*amah*” (أَمَةٌ) for the feminine. (2:228). The plural of “*amah*” (أَمَةٌ) is “*imaa*” (إِمَاءٌ) (24:32).

“أَنْ” (*an*) usually means that or which:

9:32	What they wish, is to extinguish Allah's light	يُرِيدُونَ أَنْ يُطْفِئُوا نُورَ اللَّهِ
2:184	and that if you observe the fast, it will be better for you	وَأَنْ تَصُومُوا خَيْرٌ لَكُمْ
26:33	When they came towards Lout whom we had sent. (here “ <i>un</i> ” is redundant)	وَلَمَّا أَنْ جَاءَتْ رُسُلُنَا لُوطًا
11:77	(Same verse as 26:33 except أَنْ)	وَلَمَّا جَاءَتْ رُسُلُنَا لُوطًا

Sometimes “un” is used to state the reason.

38:4	And they are surprised that somebody from among them had come to make them aware	وَعَجِبُوا أَنْ جَاءَهُمْ مُنْذِرٌ مِنْهُمْ
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In other words they are surprised that a Messenger has come from amongst themselves. But some say that here “*an*” is actually “*le an*” which means “so that” or because of, but it has not been written. It also means “so that”.

16:15	And he has made mountains on the earth to provide you with sustenance.	وَالْقَى فِي الْأَرْضِ رَوَاسِيَ أَنْ تَمِيدَ بِكُمْ
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Or you stay comfortably on it as it turns round or revolves.

Some think “*laam*” or “*le*” is not written here as well.

Sometime it means “saying that” as in:

16:36	And we sent a messenger to every nation, saying that people should only accept Allah's subjugation.	وَلَقَدْ بَعَثْنَا فِي كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ رَسُولًا أَنْ اعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ
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It also means “so that it may not” as in:

4:176	Allah tells you these things openly so that you may not be at fault.	يُبَيِّنُ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ أَنْ تَضِلُّوا
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Also means: so that if this happens, then... For instance:

2:282	If it so happens that one of them makes a mistake, then...	أَنْ تَضِلَّ إِحْدَاهُمَا
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Means “if”:

8:38	Say to the opposers that if they stop, then what has been shall be corrected	قُلْ لِلَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا إِنْ يَنْتَهُوا يُغْفَرْ لَهُمْ
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Sometimes it means “no” as in:

37:15	And they said, no, this is clear deception.	وَقَالُوا إِنْ هَذَا إِلَّا سِحْرٌ مُبِينٌ
35:41	if they move (away) then nobody can stop them.	وَلَئِنْ زَالَتْ إِنْ أَمْسَكْنَاهُمْ

Also see the heading (*S-H-R*)

Sometimes it is the abbreviation of “*inna*” and means surely, indeed. As in:

87:9	Then keep reminding them, surely this reminder is beneficial	فَذَكِّرْ إِنْ نَفَعَتِ الذِّكْرَى
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Some think that “*in*” here is conditional and the verse means that one should only speak of Allah when it is beneficial or else one should wait for the right time.

When “**in**” is the abbreviation of “**inna**”, then it definitely asserts something as in:

62:2	and verily they were, before this, in clear digress	وَإِنْ كَانُوا مِنْ قَبْلُ لَفِي ضَلَالٍ مُبِينٍ
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Sometimes it is redundant or additional. That is, it bears no meaning at all. Therefore some people think that in the following verse, “un” is redundant.

46:26	and verily we had endowed them with such grandeur as we had granted you	وَلَقَدْ مَكَّنَّاكُمْ فِي مَا آتَيْنَاكُمْ مِنْ قَبْلُ إِنَّ مَكَّنَّاكُمْ فِيهِ
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But if here “in” is taken to mean “no” then the meaning would be: we gave them such grandeur as have not even given you.

Sometime it means “**iz**” which means “because”:

5:112	Guard (be the sentinel to) God’s law because you are a Momin	اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ مُؤْمِنِينَ
2:172	And be thankful for God’s bounties to you, because you are obedient to Him.	وَاشْكُرُوا لِلَّهِ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ إِيَّاهُ تَعْبُدُونَ

“**illa**” (illa) is the same as (لا + ان) (in+la). See heading “**illa**” (illa)

Aنا Ana

It is used for both masculine and feminine.

“أَنَا رَجُلٌ” (ana rajul): I am a man.

“أَنَا امْرَأَةٌ” (ana imra’a): I am a woman.

Quran says:

2:258	I give life and death	أَنَا أَحْيِي وَأُمِيتُ
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The feminine plural for “أَنَا” (ana), is “نَحْنُ” (nahno).

أنتِ Anta

“أَنْتَ رَجُلٌ” (anta rajal): that you are a man.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says:

2:35	Let you and your partners live in the garden	اسْكُنْ أَنْتَ وَزَوْجُكَ الْجَنَّةَ
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Its feminine is “أَنْتُمْ” (antuma) and plural is “أَنْتُمْ” (antun).

أنتِ Anti

“أَنْتِ امْرَأَةٌ” (anteh imrah): that you are a woman. The feminine is “أَنْتُمْ” (antuma) and plural is “أَنْتُمْ” (antoon).

أنتُمْ Antam

“أَنْتُمْ رِجَالٌ” (antum rijal) meant that you are all men. The singular is “أَنْتَ” (ant).

The Quran says:

2:132	you are all Muslims	وَأَنْتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ
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It is used for masculine as well as feminine. “أَنْتُمَا رُجُلَانِ” (*antuma rojalan*): you are both men.
 “أَنْتُمَا إِمْرَأَتَانِ” (*antuma imrataan*): you are both women.

Surah *Al-Qasas* says:

28:35	you two, and whosoever follows you will prevail	أَنْتُمَا وَمَنِ اتَّبَعُكُمَا الْعَالِيُونَ
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“أَنْتُنَّ” (*antun*) is the deviation for plural feminine. “أَنْتُنَّ نِسْوَةٌ” (*antunn-niswah*): you are all women. The singular is “أَنْتِ” (*anti*).

“أَنْتَ” (*anthun*) basically means “soft”.

“حَدِيدٌ أَنْتٌ” (*hadeedun anees*): soft iron.

“أَرْضٌ أَنْتٌ” (*ardun aneesa*) is soft earth.

“سَيْفٌ أَنْتٌ” (*saifun anees*) is soft sword which doesn't cut.

“أَنْتَ لَهُ” (*anasa lahu*): that he became soft for him, which means that he developed a soft corner for him {T}.

Raghib says since the female as against the male of all species is softer, as such the female is called “أَنْتٌ” (*unsa*). Therefore all things, in which there is some weakness, are called “أَنِيتٌ” (*anees*). This is also why all soft stones are called “الْإِنَاتُ” (*al inaas*). And all such things which are worshipped as against God are called (with reference to their weakness in contrast to God) “إِنَاتٌ” (*inaas*).

As surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:117	They call upon the weak ones, instead of it	إِنْ يَدْعُونَ مِنْ دُونِهِ إِلَّا إِنَاتًا
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Here “إِنَاتٌ” (*inaas*): weak even if they are stone idols.

Quran uses “ذَكَرٌ” (*zakar*) as against feminine of “أُنْثَى” (*unsa*) in 4:11. As against “بَنِيْنٌ” (*baneen*) meaning sons, is also used “إِنَاتٌ” (*inaas*) meaning daughters, in 17:40.

Injeel has many meanings. Besides them it also means “flowing water” and “نَجَلَّتْ الْأَرْضُ” (*najalatal ard*): that land became fertile.

“نَجَلَّتِ الشَّيْءُ” (*najalas shaiyi*): he disclosed it. Some say “الْإِنْجِيلُ” (*al-injeel*) has been derived from this {T}.

But **Muheet** says that this word has been derived from “أَوْنَجِيلُونُ” (*awaljiloon*) which means good news or happy tidings.

Ibn Faris says “الْإِنْجِيلُ” (*al-injeel*) has come from “نَجَلَّتِ الشَّيْءُ” (*najalas shaiyi*) which means, I extracted him, meaning “made clear” or “described openly.” Its basic meaning is wideness or vastness in something.

The Quran has used this word for the Book (Bible) which was presented to **Isa** (Jesus). (57:27)

The history of this Book, **al-anjeel** or Bible can be viewed in the first chapter of my book “**Meraj Insaniyat**”. This will make it clear that the book is totally not in its original form. **Isa**’s Holy Book which he left with his friends is not to be found anymore. Later when the church became the battle ground of Jews and non-Jewish elements, people of different schools of thought began compiling their own version of the bible. The Encyclopaedia Britannica says that as many as thirty four Bibles can be traced from that period. These were actually the biographies of the Christ as culled from tradition. Jesus and his band’s language was Irami but it is surprising that all the 34 bibles (excepting one which is now found nowhere) were not in the Irami language. They were all in the Greek language. **Niqa**’s famous council (held in 325 B.C.) selected four out of these 34 bibles and the rest were declared false.

These four selected **Injeels** and the letters which are linked to St. Paul and the band (the 12 friends of Christ) are called the New Testaments. But none of them is found on this earth in its original shape. At present, there are only three ancient volumes of the bible. One is with the Vatican, the second in the British Museum and the third was sold by Russia to England. The first two volumes are of the Fifth Century whereas the third one is of the Fourth Century. In the fourth century, Jerome translated it from Greek to Latin. This translation is the basis of the translation which was published during King James’ rule (1611) and which translation is considered authentic.

In 1870 there was a conference in Canterbury of 27 big Christian scholars who decided that since this translation was not correct, a new translation was needed. This was called the Revised Edition. But this does not mean that the translations now available are according to those two translations. Not at all. Every new volume which is published by the Bible Societies is different from the previous one. The difference is so pronounced that when Dr. Mel collected some revised edition volumes, he found thirty thousand differences! And when he probed deeper, then he found as many as one million differences. For details see the chapter named Gospel of the Encyclopaedia Britannica and the chapter titled Bible of the book Encyclopaedia of Religions and Ethics.

This, briefly, is the Bible which the Christians think is a celestial book. Remember that these differences do not appear in the bibles as errors. They have been made deliberately as a virtuous deed which is thought to invoke the Blessings. As such even St. Paul is on record as stating:

“**If God’s truth was manifest due to his omnipotence, then why am I ordered like a sinner?**” (Letters to the Romans 2:7)

How this was possible, only one example will suffice (to make the contradiction clear): Dr. Jude, in his book God and Evil, writes that: “**The thing that is most condemnable is the character of Christ that the bibles present (page 319).**” This will make one realize that Quran did the Christian world a great favour when it described **Maryam** and **Isa**’s tales in the right perspective.

“إِنْسٌ” (*uns*): to be familiar with.
 “الْحُمُرُ الْإِنْسِيَّةُ” (*alhumurul insiyato*): pet donkeys.
 “جِمَارٌ وَحْشِيٌّ” (*himarun wahshiun*): wild donkeys.
 “إِسْنَسُ الْوَحْشِيِّ” (*istanasal wahshi*): that the wild animal is familiarized.
 “إِنْسٌ فَلَانٌ” (*insun fulaan*): man’s special friend.

“إِنْسٌ” (*ins*) is used for “man” and the singular is “إِنْسِيٌّ” (*insiun*). “النَّاسُ” (*an-nas*) is that tribe which is settled somewhere {T}{L}.

Those gypsy tribes which move from place to place and stay away from one’s vision are called “جِنٌّ” (*jinn*). See heading (J-N-N).

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of “إِنْسٌ” (*ins*) is to be evident as against “جِنٌّ” (*jinn*) which means to be non-evident. The plural is “أَنَاسٌ” (*unas*) and “أَنَاسِيٌّ” (*anasi*). Some think that “النَّاسُ” (*an-nas*) is also its plural.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:60	all the tribes found their drinking spot.	فَدَّ عَلِمَ كُلُّ أُنَاسٍ مَّشْرَبَهُمْ
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Here *onas* means tribes. In the sense of the human race, *unasi* and *an-naas* appear in surah *Al-Furqan* 25:50, and 25:49.

About the word “إِنْسَانٌ” (*insaana*), there are many versions, but some think that it has come from the word “إِنْسٌ” (*ins*). Quran uses “إِنْسَانٌ” (*insaana*), and “بَشَرٌ” (*bashar*) as alternatives. 15:26 and 15:28. Besides this, the word “إِنْسِيَّةٌ” (*inseyan*) has also appeared along with *bashar* in 19:26.

For the difference between *insaana* and *bashar*, see heading (B-Sh-R).

As said before, “النَّاسُ” (*an-anas*) is the plural of “إِنْسٌ” (*ins*). Some also think that it is a collective noun like “قَوْمٌ” (*qaum*). Some believe that “النَّاسُ” (*an-anas*) was “أَنَاسٌ” (*onaas*) to start with, which is the plural of *ins*. Some also think that it was “أَلْأَنَاسُ” (*al-unasi*) at first, and gradually only *an-naas* remained. {T}

“أَنَاسٌ” (*anas*): to see and feel.

In *Moosa’s* tale it is said:

20:10 27:7	I have seen a <i>naar</i>	إِنِّي أَنَسْتُ نَارًا
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Here “أَنَاسٌ” (*anas*): to see.

Muheet says that “إِنْيَاسٌ” (*in-naas*): to comprehend and believe something.
 “مُسْتَأْنِيسٌ” (*mustanis*): something that is familiar and well known, and without protocol.

Surah *Al-Ahzaab* says:

33:53	talk without protocol or freely	مُسْتَأْنِيسِينَ لِحَدِيثٍ
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“إِسْتَأْنِيسٌ” (*istaanus*) is to seek permission.

Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:27	Until you seek permission	حَتَّى تَسْتَأْذِنُوا
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“إِسْتَأْنِيسٌ” (*istanasu*): to seek information. A man who knocks at a door tries to find out if someone is at home, and if so, if he can enter. This word, in this manner, began to be used as *istayizan* i.e. seeking permission; this sort of seeking permission is meant to familiarize the one who has come at the door with the inmates of the house.

God in the Quran is *Rabb-in-naas*, *Malak-in-naas*, *Ilah-in-naas*:

114:1	Proclaim that I am under close protection of the provider of the <i>naas</i>	قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ النَّاسِ
114:2	The security holder over the <i>naas</i>	مَلِكِ النَّاسِ
114:3	The protector of the <i>naas</i>	إِلَهِ النَّاسِ

The Quran says about itself:

45:20	This is the provider of insight for the <i>naas</i>	هَذَا بَصَائِرُ لِلنَّاسِ
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So the invitation (to accept Islam), has no bounds of time or place and God's superiority is for the whole universe. The Quran also mentions the *jinn* and *naas*, i.e. the gypsies and civilized people together (in the same verse), and also about the creation of *jinn*s before *naas* (15:27). This means that the rural villages were created before the civilizations of cities.

For details, see heading (*J-N-N*).

A-N-F ا ن ف

“الْأَنْفُ” (*al-anf*): the nose, or tip, the strongest and hardest part of something, which is in the front. *{T}{R}*

5:45	And the nose for nose	وَالْأَنْفَ بِالْأَنْفِ
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“الْإِسْتِنَافُ” (*al-istenafu*): to begin something new. *{T}{R}*

The Arabs apply both wealth and disgrace to it. As “حَمِيَ أَنْفُهُ” (*hamiya anfahu*): that he became respected, and “رَغِمَ أَنْفُهُ” (*raghema anfahu*) he became disgraced: *{M}*.

“أَنْفًا” (*anefan*): “just now”. The Quran uses this meaning in 47:16.

A-N-M ا ن م

“الْأَنْامُ” (*al-anaam*): creations (creatures), or only *ins* and *jinn*. Some say all things on earth are called *anaam*. This is probably derived from “أَنَامَ” (*annam*) and can mean all things which are subjects to sleep *{T, R}*. Some say all living things are called “الْأَنْامُ” (*al-anaam*) *{M}*.

The Quran says:

55:10	The earth has been created for the benefit of the creations	وَالْأَرْضَ وَضَعَهَا لِلْأَنْامِ
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It is evident from this that any system in which the earth (the fountainhead of all sustenance) is reserved for a few only (or lies waste) would be against God's wishes.

To explain this, the Quran at another place says:

41:10	it should be open (available) for all needy	سَوَاءٌ لِّلْغَائِلِينَ
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For more details, see heading (*A-R-Dh*).

Inna اِنَّ

“اِنَّ” (*inna*) is used for assertion and assurance:

2:6	it is a fact that those who deny this (system of life)	اِنَّ الَّذِيْنَ كَفَرُوْا
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“اِنَّمَا” (*innama*) is used to mean “only”:

9:10	Sadaqat are only for those who are <i>fuqra</i>	اِنَّمَا الصَّدَقَاتُ لِلْفُقَرَاءِ
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It also means reiteration. See under heading “*ma*”. *Inni* is also called *innani* and *inna* is also spoken as *innana*.

Anna اَنَّ

“اَنَّ” (*anna*) is actually like “اِنَّ” (*inna*). It is used for reiteration. When it has a *kaaf* in front, it reads “كَأَنَّ” (*ka-anna*). See heading (*ka-anna*).

“اِنَّمَا” (*annama*) also means the same as “اِنَّ” (*anna*), and means reiteration.

21:108	Verily, your <i>ilah</i> is a unique <i>ilah</i> .	اِنَّمَا اِلٰهُكُمْ اِلٰهٌ وَّاحِدٌ
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“اَنَّ” (*anna*) and “اِنَّ” (*inna*) differ only in that *anna* is used in between a sentence while *inna* is used in the beginning of the sentence.

Anna اَنَّى

“اَنَّى كَيْفَ” (*anna kaifa*): how.

89:23	(and that day) how can he be reminded of the law?	وَأَنَّى لَهُ الذِّكْرَى
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“اَنَّى مَتَى” (*mata*): when:

19:8	(Zakariah) said: O my Sustainer, when will a son be born to me?	قَالَ رَبِّ اَنَّى يَكُوْنُ لِيْ غُلَامٌ
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“اَنَّى مِنْ اَيْنَ” (*min aina*):, from where?

3:36	From where did you get this?	اَنَّى لَكَ هٰذَا
6:96	where are you going backwards	فَاَنَّى تُؤْفِكُوْنَ

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:223	Your <i>nisa</i> are your fields. Come to your fields when you want to	نِسَاؤُكُمْ حَرْثٌ لَّكُمْ فَاْتُوا حَرْثَكُمْ اَنَّى شِئْتُمْ
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Here “اَنَّى” (*anaa*): whenever.

Ibn Abbas says it means, whenever in the day or night you want. *Taj-ul-Uroos* also says it means “when” (ever). In *Gharibul Quran*, *Mirza Abul Fazl* writes that it means “if you want”.

“أَتَى الشَّيْءُ” (*anish shaiyi*): the time for something has come, time for something to be strengthened, for something to be completed or reach its end.

	This (thing) has reached its completion (has matured)	بَلَغَ هَذَا أَتَاهُ وَ إِنَاهُ
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Surah *Al-Ahzaab* says:

33:53	those who wait for meal time	نَاطِرِينَ إِنَاهُ
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That is, if called for a meal, come at the scheduled time (and not too much earlier), or continue idle gossip till it is meal time and you are included for the meal (out of courtesy).

Surah *Al-Hadeed* says:

57:16	Hasn't the time for its completion come for the Momineen?	أَلَمْ يَأْنِ لِلَّذِينَ آمَنُوا
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Surah *Al-Ghashiya* says:

88:5	the stream water which has reached its extreme	عَيْنِ آتِيَةٍ
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“الْأَيْمَاءُ” (*al-inaa*): utensils {T}. Its plural is “أَيَّاهُ” (*aneyah*) as used in 76: 15.

“الْأَيْمَاءُ” (*al-inaa*) is the plural of “أَيُّ” (*aniyun*) which means a part of time:

“أَنَاءُ اللَّيْلِ” (*anaul lail*): some time (moments) in the night. (20:130) and (3:112).

Ibn Faris says “أَيُّ” (*ini*): sometime in the night.

“أَتَيْتُ الشَّيْءَ” (*anaiyo shaiyi*): that I postponed something from its scheduled time.

Muheet says that this root means “tent” in the Hebrew language. As such it means “the people who live under the same tent”. Thereafter, as *Raghib* says, it began to be used for people of the same race, religion or profession, house and city.

“أَهْلُ الرَّجُلِ” (*ahlur rajul*) is commonly used for a man's close relatives and family, and is also used for ones wife and children. “أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ” (*ahlul bait*): those who live in the same house.

Muheet says that it means a lot of things. Then with reference to *Abu Hanifa*, he says that it basically means wife.

“أَهْلِيَّ” (*ahli*) is that four-legged pet animal which becomes familiar with the house.

The Quran does give respect to relationship but the basic criteria for distinguishing people is *eeaman* and *kufr* i.e. trust and denial. Those who are bound within the same system of life, are of the same group or party, and are the individuals of the same nation, but those who are outside this bondage are members of the other group and as such “others” or strangers.

If relatives belong to the same group, then their relationship becomes stronger, but if they are not of the same group then they do not stay as one's own. This was the truth which was revealed to *Nooh* when he was told that his son was:

11:46	O <i>Nooh</i> , he is not one of your group, his acts are not virtuous	يَا نُوحُ إِنَّهُ لَيْسَ مِنْ أَهْلِكَ إِنَّهُ عَمَلٌ غَيْرُ
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Before this, *Nooh* was told that his son was not included in the Momin group. As such whether it be *Ibrahim's* father or *Nooh's* son, *Lot's* wife or the closest relative of *Muhammad*, for example his uncle,

if they are not bound within the same way of life, then they cannot be considered **ahl** or family. Such people will not be hated but will be treated humanely and justly. The **ahl** will be members of the group which will be the torch bearer of God's system, His Lordship and which will nurture the human race.

“هُوَ أَهْلٌ لِكَذَا” (*huwa hazun lekaza*): that he deserves it, this is where he belongs.

Sura **An-Nisa** says:

4:58	Allah orders you to return the security to those who have given you security	إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُكُمْ أَنْ تُؤَدُّوا الْأَمَانَاتِ إِلَى أَهْلِهَا
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If this means items that have been given for secure keeping, then it would mean: “don’t misappropriate them and return them to the owners.” If **amanaat** means other things which the elite have been given as trust, such as power, then it would mean to give it to those who deserve it and not those who don’t.

Some say that **ahl** here means those who deserve, befitting whom.

The Noble Quran mentions the **Ahlil Kitab** very often. At that time there were two groups of Arabs. One of them had a claim to some celestial book or the other. These were the **Ahlil Kitab** or “those with the Book”, and the other group which did not believe in any celestial book. They have commonly been called **mushrikeen**, i.e. who include others to Gods authority.

But **shirk** was not limited to **mushrikeen**. There were even those among **Ahlil Kitaab** who committed **shirk**. They believed on other gods too. For details see heading (Sh-R-K). Those without the Book were also called **ummiyeen**. See heading (A-M-M). From among all these, those who had belief in **Muhammed** were called **momineen**. And those who did not, were called **kafireen**. The **ahl** of the Messenger were those who obeyed him or followed him (7:83). It also means (as mentioned earlier) those who have the right, the owners, and those who have the capability (of doing something) 4:58.

Aw أو

“أو” (**aw**) is used to mean “or”.

1) To mean doubt, as in:

18:19	we have stayed for a day or some part of the day	لَبِثْنَا يَوْمًا أَوْ بَعْضَ يَوْمٍ
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This means that the speaker doesn’t know which one is correct.

2) When a choice between two things is given as:

	Either marry Hindan or her sister	تَزَوَّجْ هِنْدًا أَوْ أُخْتَهَا
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3) When “أو” (**aw**) is preceded by a negative, then it means neither of the two things:

76:24	You will neither obey or follow any Aasim or Kafur	وَلَا تُطِيعْ مِنْهُمْ أَيْمًا أَوْ كَفُورًا
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4) To mean “perhaps”:

37:147	And we sent him to hundreds of thousands; perhaps they were even more than that.	وَأَرْسَلْنَاهُ إِلَى مِثْقَةِ آلَافٍ أَوْ يَزِيدُونَ
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5) To mean “until now”:

48:16	fight them until they become obedient	ثُقَاتِلُوهُمْ أَوْ يُسْلِمُوا
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6) Sometimes it happened thus; and sometimes it happened otherwise: in this meaning:

7:4	so our devastation sometimes appeared at night and sometimes when they were resting in the afternoon	فَجَاءَهَا بِأَسَنًا نَيَّانًا أَوْ هُمْ قَائِلُونَ
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“الْأَوْبُ” (*al-aob*): to bring the legs back while running very fast.
 “الْأَوْبَاتُ” (*al-aobaat*): legs.
 “اتَّأَوَّبُ” (*at-taweeb*): to travel the whole day and to stay foot at night.
 “رِيحٌ مُوَوِّبَةٌ” (*reehun mu-awwebah*): the wind that blows the entire day. {T}
 “أَوْبٌ” (*aob*) also means to return.
 “أَوْبٌ” (*aob*) and “رُجُوعٌ” (*rujooh*) differ only in that the last mentioned is said to return with or without intent, while *aub* is only with intent.
 “الْمَابُ” (*almaab*): to return, also junction, and when something becomes oblivious, or the place from where something turns back.
 “بَيْنَهُمَا ثَلَاثُ مَوَاقِفَ” (*bainahuma salaso ma aub*): there are three places to stop between the two places.

Quran says:

88:25	they will return but to us	إِنَّ إِلَيْنَا إِنَابُهُمْ
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This means that they are traversing the path that will take them to life's happiness. They are wrong in doing so. Every step they take is moving towards the destination which we have ordained as a result of their deeds. No step of theirs can go beyond our law of consequences, which is the result of cause and effect. They are moving towards that goal, because:

88:26	every deed of theirs is subject to our laws	عَلَيْنَا حِسَابُهُمْ
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According to this system, the results of good deeds have been called “حُسْنُ الْمَابِ” (*husnul maab*) in 3:13.

In other words, good result for good deeds, but that is not the last destination. It is to stay only momentarily, because according to the Quran, *jannah* is one of the evolutionary destinations for Man. For details see heading (*J-N-N*).

About *Ayub* (a messenger) the Quran says:

38:44	turn towards the law of God	إِلَيْهِ أَوَّابٌ
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In similar meaning, the leaders of *Dawood's* nation were told:

34:11	O you leaders, turn over	يَا جِبَالُ أَوَّيْ
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Usually, *jibaa* is translated to *mountains*, but its other meanings are the leaders of the nation. See heading (*J-B-L*). If *jibaa* is taken to mean mountains, then it would mean that *Daud* used to employ the mountains for which nature has created them, i.e. for protection, to let the forests grow on them to make wood available and to provide minerals and stones. These are some of the purposes for which God has created the mountains and by doing this, the mountains obey Him.

The basic meaning of the word is for something to bend or become crooked (*Ibn Faris*). In other words, it means to get bent due to a heavy load or burden.

“الْأَوْدُ” (*al-awad*): to bend.
 “الْأَوْدُ” (*al-awad*): to bend or make crooked, to offend, to be a burden.
 “الْأَوْدَةُ” (*al-audah*): load, or to become a burden (for something).
 “أَدَّهُ الْأَمْرُ” (*aadahul amr*): that some burden has bent his back.
 “تَأَوَّدَهُ الْأَمْرُ” (*ta-awwadal amr*): that this matter has burdened him.

The Quran says:

2:255	the control of the universe is no burden to God	وَلَا يُؤْدُّهُ حِفْظُهُمَا
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Ibn Faris says it means both the beginning and end of some work.

- “آل إِلَيْهِ أَوَّلًا” (*ala ilaihey awla*): he went back to him, returned to him.
 “آل عَنْهُ” (*ala-unhu*) turned from him. Basically the word means to return and focus.
 “أَوَّلَ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكَ ضَالًّا” (*awwal-allahu a’laika zalaka*): Let Allah return your lost thing to you.
 “مَال” (*maal*) is the point to which a thing at last returns, or the last result of anything.
 “تَأْوِيل” (*ta’weelun*): to return something to its right path.
 “أَوَّلَ الْكَلَامِ تَأْوِيلًا” (*awwala alklama taweela*): he explained the results and assessment.
 “آلَ عَلَى الْقَوْمِ” (*aala a’liyya-al-qoum*): he became the friend of the nation.
 “آلَ الْمَالِ وَانْتَالَهُ” (*aala al-mala wa antalahu*): he looked after the wealth, arranged for it, corrected it.
 “الْإِيَالَه” (*al-iyalah*): politics, limits of the state.
 “آل” (*aala*): to be reduced, to get rid of.
 “أَوَّل” (*awwal*) is the opposite for “آخِر” (last). 57:3. This means that **awwal** means the very first.

Raghib says that “أَنَا أَوَّلُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ” (*ana awwalul muslemeen*): that I am the first to bow before the laws of Allah and thus am an example for others.

Quran says Allah is **al-awwal** (the first) in 57:3. This indicates his infinity which human concept can not grasp.

“أَوَّلَ الرَّجُلِ يَأُولُ أَوَّلًا” (*awilar-rajulu yawalu aawalaa*): he became the precede, he attained number one (position). “أُولَى” (*Oola*) is the feminine gender {T}.

Quran says:

79:25	The last and the first	الْآخِرَةُ وَالْأُولَى
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“آل” (*al*) mean the members of one’s family, his friends, or those who are obedient to him. “آل” (*al*) is used among gentlemen only, not among the dregs of society. {T}

When Quran says “آلِ يَعْقُوبَ” (*ale Yaqub*) in 19:6, it means the children, friends or obedient of **Yaqob**.

“آلِ فِرْعَوْنَ” (*ala firoun*): likewise the obedient one of the Pharaoh.

“الْأَلَّة” (*ala lateh*): situation, instruments or gadgets. The plural is “الْأَلَّتْ” (*aalaat*).

Quran uses the word “تَأْوِيل” (*taweel*) to mean the last result, outcome, last verdict:

4:59	This is the right way (of living) and it will have a good result	ذَلِكَ خَيْرٌ وَأَحْسَنُ تَأْوِيلًا
7:53	now they are waiting for the veracity of this book?	هَلْ يَنْظُرُونَ إِلَّا تَأْوِيلَهُ

I.e. they are waiting for what this book says will take place to take place. In the narrative about **Moosa** (Moses) and his traveling companion (elder), the companion says in the end:

18:78	I will now tell you about the things about which you were so eager and restless.	سَأُبَيِّنُكَ بِتَأْوِيلِ مَا لَمْ تَسْتَطِعْ عَلَيْهِ صَبْرًا
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Yaqoob had said about **Yusuf**:

12:6	God will give you such insight that you will get to the bottom of things instantly	وَيُعَلِّمُكَ مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ
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This means that he will reach the final result by knowing the beginning. That is why interpretation of dreams is also called **taweel**.

12:36	Inform us about the interpretations	نَبِّئْنَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ
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About **ayaateh mutashabeaat**, those verses or sentences which are inexplicable by us because they are beyond human comprehension, it has been said in the Quran:

3:7	Whatever the interpretation of this knowledge is, lies with none other than Allah and those who keep acquiring substance in this knowledge	وَمَا يَعْلَمُ تَأْوِيلَهُ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَالرَّاسِخُونَ فِي الْعِلْمِ
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For details, see heading **(Sh-B-He)** and **(H-K-M)**.

Oulai أولاء

“أولاء” (**oulai**) is a noun and means “all this”. Its singular is “ذَا” (**za**). See also heading “ذَا” (**za**).
 “أولائك” (**oulaikah**): “*they all*”. Its singular is “ذَلِكَ” (**zaak**) and “ذَالِكْ” (**zalik**).
 “أولائكم” (**oulaikum**): “*all of them*” as in 4:91. It is used for both masculine and feminine genders.

It also appears as a warning such as:

11:78	These are my daughters?	هَؤُلَاءِ بَنَاتِي
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Oulu أولوا

“أولوا” (**oulu**) is also a noun and means “with” such as:

38:43	those with intellect and insight	لِأُولِي الْأَلْبَابِ
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The singular is “ذُو” (**zu**). “أولات” (**oulaat**) is plural and feminine in gender. The singular is “ذَاتٌ” (**zaat**)

65:6	those with burden (responsibility or pregnancy)	أُولَاتٍ حَمِلٍ
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A-W-N ا و ن

“الآن” (**al-aan**) is the present time, now, at this time. {**T**}.

2:71	Now you are telling the truth.	الآن جئت بالحق
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A-W-He ا و ه

“آه” (**ah**), “أوه” (**auho**), “آويهي” (**awihi**). All these are expressions of pain and complaint.

“أواه” (**al-awwah**) is a person who uses the expression of “تأوه” (**taawoho**) very much, which means to express anger and sorrow. As such it signifies a person who is easily brought to tears and very commiserate and sorrowful at people’s plight {**T**}. It is also used for a very understanding person and for one who prays a lot. {**T**}

Ibrahim is called “أواه حليم” (**awwahun haleem**) 9:114 which means commiserate, one who grieved over other’s plight.

Ibn Faris says the word basically means “to gather”, and “to pity and fear”.

“أَوَيْتُ مَنْزِلِي” (*awaito manzili*): I got down (landed) at my house, or returned to it, or lived in it.

“أَوَيْ إِلَيْهِ” (*awa ilaih*): to lean towards someone and become enamoured.

“أَوَيْتُ لَهُ” (*awaito lahu*): I felt pity for him.

“رَجَعْتُ إِلَيْهِ بِقَلْبِي” (*rajata ilaihi biqalbi*): I became enamoured of him from the heart. {R}

“الْمَاوِي” (*al-mawa*): place to returns during day or night, a place where a camels return at night to rest. {T}

“الْأَوِي” (*al-awyo*): birds that remain in flocks

“الْمَاوِي” (*al mawia*): the garden where one can spend the night.

“أَوَيْتُهُ” (*awaitohu*): I got him down at my house {T}. Also see heading (*Th-W-Y*)

The Quran says:

11:43	I will go towards the mountain to escape	سَاوِي إِلَى جَبَلٍ
23:50	We gave shelter to (Jesus and Mary)	أَوَيْنَاهُمَا
33:51	to give shelter near oneself	تُرْجِي مَنْ تَشَاءُ مِنْهُمْ وَتُؤْوِي
8:26	God sheltered you	فَاوَأَكُم

Quran calls *jannah* as *Al-mawa* in 53:15 which means the place where one can live in peace and without any fear. Where one does not need to fear that somebody will snatch it away:

But the same word has also been used for *Jahannum*:

3:151	You will live permanently in fire	وَمَا أَوَاهُمْ النَّارُ
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Because as per the root, *mawa* is any place that is a destination, center, or living place.

“إِي” (*Iy*): yes, as in:

10:53	tell them, yes, it is undoubtedly so	قُلْ إِي وَرَبِّي إِنَّهُ حَقٌّ
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“إِي” (*Iy*) must be followed by words of swearing.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are protection and strength.

“أَد” (*ad*), “يَيْدُ” (*yaid*), “أَيْدَا” (*aida*), they all mean to be strengthened, to become hard.

“الْأَد” (*al-aado*): hardness or strength.

“الْأَيْدُ” (*al-ayd*): the same.

“ذَا الْأَيْدُ” (*za al-ayd*): strong man.

“أَيَّدْتُهُ قَائِدًا” (*ayyatohu tayeeda*): to strengthen something very much.

“الْإِيَادُ” (*al iyad*): that which is used to give strength.

It also means mud which is placed around the edges of a tent so that rain water does not enter. It also means high dune, or strong mountain.

2:87	And We strengthened Isa (Jesus) through <i>Rooh-ul-Qudus</i> (Holy Spirit)	وَأَيَّدْنَاهُ بِرُوحِ الْقُدُسِ
51:47	We have built the universe with great strength	وَالسَّمَاءَ بَنَيْنَاهَا بِأَيْدٍ

“أَيْدُ” (*ayid*) is the plural of “يَدُ” (*yad*) (hand). See heading (Y-D-Y).

“الْأَيْكُ” (*al aiyk*): a lot of trees, a bunch of trees, a wood which has berry trees etc. proliferation of any kind of trees. “اَيْكَةٌ” (*aikah*) is its singular.

Quran says:

15:78	People of the woods	أَصْحَابُ الْأَيْكَةِ
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It is said for the people of *Madyan* who lived in dense forests.

“الْأَيَّامُ” (*al iyaam*): “smoke”.

“أَمْ يَنْتِمْ وَيَوْمَ لِيَامًا” (*aama yaimu wa yauwmu iyaama*): in order to get to the beehive he smoked it so that the bees fly away and the hive is left alone.

“الْأَيِّمُ” (*al-ayim*): a woman with no husband. Its plural is “الْأَيَّامُ” (*al-ayama*).

There was an Arab proverb that said “الْحَرْبُ مَا يَمَّةٌ لِلنِّسَاءِ” (*alharbu ma yamatun lillanisa*) which mean that war turns women into widows

The Quran says:

24:32	Those among you who are single, let them be married. (Either bachelors, or spinsters, married or unmarried, widowers or widows, all are included) {T, M}	وَأَنْكِحُوا الْأَيَّامَ
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It is evident from this that it is also among the duties of an Islamic society to create an environment in which individuals are able to live a life of connubial bliss.

“أَيْنَ” (*ain*): where, whither, which place.

“أَيْنَمَا” (*ainama*):, where, wherever.

75:10	There is no escape	أَيْنَ الْمَفَرِّ
2:148	Wherever you be, God will collect you (all).	أَيْنَ مَا تَكُونُوا يَأْتِ بِكُمْ اللَّهُ جَمِيعًا

“أَيَّ” (*ayyon*): who, which, which one:

7:185	Then besides this hadith, on what will these people believe?	فَبِأَيِّ حَدِيثٍ بَعْدَهُ يُؤْمِنُونَ
17:110	Call him by what name you will, all well balanced named belongs to him.	أَيُّا مَا تَدْعُوا فَلَهُ الْأَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَى

It is also used to call someone, to call out, like “يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ” (*ya ayyo han-naas*) which means O people.

Iyya أَيَّا

There is a sense of abbreviation in it, it doesn't come by itself but has a pronoun with it.

1:4	4 we accept only your subjugation	إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ
16:51	so keep following me	فَلْيَأْيَ فَارْهَبُونَ
6:152	we give you <i>rizq</i> as well as them i.e. we feed you as well as them	نَحْنُ نَرْزُقُكُمْ وَإِيَّاهُمْ

Ayyaan أَيَّانَ

It means "when":

7:187	they ask of you when will the moment of revolution come?	يَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ السَّاعَةِ أَيَّانَ مُرْسَاهَا
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Ayyub أَيُّوبَ

Ishaq had two sons, *Yaqub* and *Eesu*. *Eesu* went to his uncle *Ismail* and married his daughter. He had several children among whom *Amaliq* and *Eewaz* became well known. *Eesu*'s nickname was *Adoom* (pinkish) and hence his dynasty was called *Adoomi*. The area in the centre between the Dead Sea and the *Uqaba* Gulf was where he lived. In the Torah it is called the *Koh* or Mount *Siir*. The capital was *Raqeem*. *Ayub* belonged to the *Eewaz* tribe. In the Torah, *Ayyub*'s travel is mentioned. *Yubab*, *Oub* and *Aayub* are the same name (*Ayyub*). The period was between 700 and 1000 B.C. Although some researchers think that his period was prior to Moses. His tale is written therein and as is usual with the Torah, the tale has been garnished a lot. The Quran has mentioned only one phase of his life when he was in severe difficulties but he tolerated them with great courage and perseverance. For details see 21: 83 and 84 and 38: 44 and 49.

“آية” (*ayah*): visible evidence, symbol or sign. As such, landmarks are called *ayah*. Actually, *ayah* is necessarily the visible part of anything that is hidden, and when one can understand or comprehend the visible part, and then he can even guess as to what the invisible part means. {*R, T, M*}. God’s personality cannot come within the purview of human comprehension, therefore, it can only be guessed from the visible signs which abound in the universe. As such, this universe and everything within it are called *ayah* of Allah. These verses are the marks of which we can have some idea of (man’s) “destiny”. The biggest *ayah* in the human world is “*wahi*” or revelation. It is therefore also an *ayah* of Allah. Every part or verse of the Noble Quran is called an “*ayah*”. The message brought by a Messenger is also called the *ayah* {*L*}

Saleh said to his nation “whether you honour Allah’s law or not, I have decided to let this camel go free. This camel is here called *ayah*:

7:73	this (female) camel is a sign for you	هَذِهِ نَافَةُ اللَّهِ لَكُمْ آيَةٌ
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Similarly the Quran calls *Nooh’s* Ark *ayah* as well

29:15	A sign for all the world	آيَةٌ لِلْعَالَمِينَ
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It was called a sign because it was a sign that the nation which will obey the law of God will be safe from harm. In short, everything which draws Man’s attention towards God is an ayat.

Besides that, even reasoning could be an *ayah*:

17:12	points to these very reasoning	وَجَعَلْنَا اللَّيْلَ وَالنَّهَارَ آيَاتَيْنِ
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In other words, by deliberating Man can reach the understanding that the universe is not static, but dynamic. In surah *Ash-Shoa’ra*, the word *ayah* has also been used for a memorial. 26:128

Iyan nabaat means that *ayaah* is the beauty of flowers of plants. {*L*}

“آيَا الشَّمْسِ” (*aiya-ash-shamsi*): rays or indications of the sun {*T, M*}.

“تَأَيَّأَ” (*ta ayah*): to stop at someplace.

“تَأَيَّأَ بِالْمَكَانِ” (*ta ayah bil makan*): he stopped at that place and got late.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to stop and deliberate, or to intend and decide.

“To wait and deliberate” throws a very illuminating light on the particularities of *ayahs*. The phrase would mean that all of the various things in the world are *ayahs*, every one of them. But they can be *ayahs* (signs) only for those who stop and deliberate on them. By deliberating on them, one’s mind will naturally go towards their Creator. Similarly, by deliberating on the Quranic *ayah s*, a human being can reach his rightful destiny. If one does not stop and think about it, then the *ayah* cannot lead to the real meaning of life. In this way, it would not be an *ayah* in the real sense.

B (حرف)

The following examples will make the use of this letter clear:

- “أَمْسَكْتُ بِزَيْدٍ” (*amsaktu bi zaid*): I caught Zaid
 “مَرَرْتُ بِزَيْدٍ” (*marartu bi zaid*): I went **past** Zaid
 “ذَهَبَ زَيْدٌ” (*zahaba zaid*): Zaid went
 “ذَهَبْتُ بِزَيْدٍ” (*zahabtu bi zaid*): I went **with** Zaid, or I took Zaid with me.

The Quran says:

4:43	do the “ masah ” on your faces (wipe one’s hands over the face without water, while performing ablution).	فَامْسَحُوا بِوُجُوهِكُمْ
25:72	When they walk past by fault.	إِذَا مَرُّوا بِاللَّغْوِ
2:17	Allah deprived them of their light	ذَهَبَ اللَّهُ بِنُورِهِمْ
2:54	You have been unkind to yourself due to worshipping a calf.	ظَلَمْتُمْ أَنْفُسَكُمْ إِتِّخَاذِكُمْ
11:48	<i>Nooh</i> , dismount with safety	نُوحُ اهْبِطْ بِسَلَامٍ مِنَّا
96:4	he taught with (through) the pen	عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ

To indicate time or place, meaning “in”:

54:34	We saved them in the morning	بَحَيْنَاهُمْ بِسَحْرِ
3:123	truly Allah has helped you in the field of <i>Badr</i>	وَلَقَدْ نَصَرَكُمُ اللَّهُ بِبَدْرِ

In exchange for something, as in:

12:20	And they sold him (<i>Yusuf</i>) in exchange for a small price.	وَشَرُّهُ بِتَمَنِ بَخْسٍ
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To mean “**على**” (*a’la*) or “over”, the Quran says:

4:42	If the earth could be levelled over them.	لَوْ تُسَوَّى بِهِمُ الْأَرْضُ
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To mean “from”, as in:

25:59	About him, inquire from someone who knows	فَاسْأَلْ بِهِ خَبِيرًا
76:6	the stream from which servants of Allah drink	عَيْنًا يَشْرَبُ بِهَا عِبَادُ اللَّهِ

Some think that the way “**من**” (*min*) is used here, means “some”. Not full, but a part. As such, some people maintain that the following verse should be translated as shown below:

5:6	Do the “ <i>masaah</i> ” over a part of the head	وَامْسَحُوا بِرُءُوسِكُمْ
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At some places this letter is additional and doesn’t mean anything, as in:

13:43	Allah is witness enough	كُفَى بِاللَّهِ شَهِيدًا
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Even if “*beh*” had not been used in the above verse, it would generate the same meaning.

Mirza Abul Fazal writes in his book *Gharib-ul-Quran* that the “*beh*” in “*بِسْمِ اللَّهِ*” (*bismillah*) is to invoke help.

“*بِاللَّهِ*” (*billah*): to swear on Allah. This means that “*beh*” is also used to swear.

“الْبَيْرُ” (*al-bi'aro*): “water well”.

Its actual meaning is of a hole which has its opening camouflaged so if someone goes over it, he may fall into it. In other words, a dug trap. Although, it is not unthinkable that the use of this word can apply to other meanings as well.

The Quran says:

22:45	blind (useless) wells	وَبُيُوتٌ مُّغَطَّلَةٌ
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“بَيْسٌ” (*beys*): “bad”. It is usually used in past tense, but has no definitive derivative. Its forms are formed by combining the root letters directly, as “نَعِمَ” (*naima*) from “نِعم” (*ni'm*). It is sometimes accompanied with “مَا” (*ma*), for instance “بِئْسَمَا” (*bi'usama*) in 2:90.

“الْبِئْسُ” (*al-basū*): severe plight, raging battle, hardness, strength etc.

“لَا بَأْسَ عَلَيْكَ” (*la basa alaika*) or, “لَا خَوْفٌ بُوْسَ الرَّجُلِ” (*la khaufa bo- sa rajal*): the man became brave.

“بِئْسَ الرَّجُلُ بُوْسًا” (*ba'esar rajulu yu-sa*): the man became very needy.

“الْبِئْسَاءُ” (*al-ba'sa'o*): intensity.

“عَذَابٌ بَيْسٌ” (*azabun ba'is*): severe punishment, a punishment in which economy is affected.

“الْبِئْسَاءُ” (*al-ba'sao*) also means hunger {M}.

“الْبِئْسَاءُ” (*al-basa'o*): the loss of wealth {M}.

“الضَّرَاءُ” (*az-zarrao*): physical harm, like disease etc. {M}.

“الْمُبْتَئِسُ” (*al-mubtaus*): a sad person {M}.

The Quran says:

18:2	unpleasant results of wrong deeds	بِئْسًا شَدِيدًا مُّقَابِلَهُ أَجْرًا حَسَنًا
7:4	When Our punishment came to that dwelling	فَجَاءَهَا بَأْسُنَا

This implies that due to their wrong deeds, the law of nature was activated, and severe plight was encountered. In surah *Bani Israel*, there is mention of a warring tribe which used to bring “أُولَى بَأْسٍ” (*ooli baas*), that is, severe plight.

Surah *Al-Hadeedh* says:

57:25	there is great hardness in it	فِيهِ بَأْسٌ شَدِيدٌ
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“إِبْتِئَاسٌ” (*ibteasun*): to take offend, to be sad.

In surah *Hoodh*, *Noah* has been addressed:

11:37	Don't worry about a thing of what these opponents do	فَلَا تُبْتَئِسْ بِمَا كَانُوا يَفْعَلُونَ
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The city of *Babel* (Babylon) was the centre of ancient Caledonian civilization. The Quran has mentioned this city and denied the mythical stories that are related with it in reference to *Solamon* in Jewish literature:

2:102	And in <i>Babel</i> , no such revelation was made to <i>Haroot</i> and <i>Marut</i> (two angels, supposedly).	وَمَا نَزَّلَ عَلَى الْمَلَكَيْنِ بِبَابِلَ هَارُوتَ وَ مُارُوتَ
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These were all tales fabricated by those resistors themselves.

“الْبُتْرُ” (*al-butar*): to cut something, before it is complete or matures {*Ibn Faris*}.

It also means to cut off a tail at its root.

“سَيْفٌ بَاتِرٌ” (*saifun batir*): the sword which cuts.

“الْأَبْتَرُ” (*al-abtaro*) unrequited, a pauper who has nothing, childless, one whose dynasty has its root cut off, after whose death, no trace of his name or good deeds shall remain {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

108:3	no trace of your opponent	إِنَّ شَانِئَكَ هُوَ الْأَبْتَرُ
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The meaning of “no trace” in this context is that their strength and grandeur, due to which they so oppose you, will end and they will have no part from the better things of life.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to cut. The basic meaning of “بَتَكَ” (*batak*) is to cut, or to get hold of feathers and wrench them out. As such “الْبَيْكَةُ” (*al-bitkah*): the rooted out feathers. This would mean that “بَتَكَ” (*batak*): to root out, but it figuratively means to cut the ears of animals, or split them and let them go free in the name of idols {*T, M, R*}. This was the practice in heathen Arabia.

Surah *An-Nisaa* says:

4:219	So they will split the ears of animals.	فَلْيَبْطِكُوا آذَانَ الْأَنْعَامِ
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“السَّيْفُ الْبَاتِكُ” (*as-aaiful batik*): a sword that cuts {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to differentiate something from other things.

“بَتَّلَهُ” (*batalau*) or “يَبْتُلُوهُ” (*yabtolohu*): he separated her.

“فَانْبَتَلَ” (*fa'anbatal*): hence he was separated.

“تَبَتَّلَ” (*tabattal*) also means the same as above.

“الْبُتُولُ” (*al-batool*) is a woman who stays away from men, or who stays away from marriage.

“الْمُبَتَّلَةُ” (*al-mubattala*) is a beautiful woman, who has fine (beautiful) limbs.

“تَبَتَّلَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ” (*tabattalatil mar'aa*): the woman finished her make-up.

“الْمُبْتَلِ” (*al-mubtil*): being different from others.

“الْبَتْلُ” (*al-batl*) is the truth, or one's right. {*T*}

“إِنْبَتَلَ فِي سَيْرِهِ” (*inbatala fee sairih*): he tried to walk fast.

Quran says:

73:8	To cut off from everybody (everything) and to follow Allah only, and engage oneself in efforts to establish His system	وَنَبِّئْهُنَّ إِلَيْهِ تَبَيُّنًا
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When the Messenger was given the principles of Allah's system, he was ordered to form a group of those who were loyal to him, and to carry out its implementation, and in doing so, not to heed the opponents in any way:

6:92	Proclaim to Allah, and leave the opponents aside	قُلِ اللَّهُ ثُمَّ ذَرْهُمْ
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When a man decides upon the end (goal), then he should shelve ifs and buts, and with the goal in mind, take every step towards that goal. All this should be done in a nice way, because “تَبَتَّلَ” (*tabattul*) has a connotation of décor as well.

“بُثُّ” (*bus*) is to spread out and disturb something, thus it also means to spread, as well as increase (proliferate). {T}

Muheet's compiler says that it means to invent and create. While asserting these meanings, *Raghib* has added that “بُثُّ” (*bus*) also means to disclose something which was previously hidden. Therefore, it also means to make such things obvious, which were unclear earlier. {T, L}

Ibn Faris also says that its basic meaning is to disclose or distribute (without any pattern).

“بُثُّ الْغُبَارِ” (*bus alghubar*): to raise dust.

“بَيَّنْتُكَ السِّرَّ” (*basastokash shir*): I disclosed the secret to you.

“أَبَسْتُكَ” (*absustoka*): I disclosed (the reason of) my sorrow to you. {T}

“الْبَسُّ” (*al-basso*) is that sorrow which cannot remain hidden. {T}

The Quran says:

2:164	God spread out every kind of living thing on earth, and proliferated them (created them abundantly).	وَبُثُّ فِيهَا مِنْ كُلِّ دَابَّةٍ
101:4	like flies spread around	كَالْفَرَاشِ الْمُبْثُوثِ
56:7	the spread particles in the air	هَبَاءٌ مُبْتَثَّتًا
12:86	I complain due to my suffering and my grief	أَشْكُو بَنِي وَحُرْنِي

This makes it clear that “بُثُّ” (*bus*) is sadness other than sorrow, and means such sadness which cannot be kept hidden.

“بَجَسَ الْمَاءُ” (*bajasal ma'a*): for the water to split something, and to flow out.

“مَاءٌ بَاجِسٌ” (*ma'un bajus*): water that flows out in this manner {T}.

The Quran mentions:

7:160	streams of water flowed out of it	فَانْبَجَسَتْ مِنْهُ
2:60	Then gushed forth	فَانْفَجَرَتْ

Raghib says when water flows from a narrow opening it is called “انْبِجَاسٌ” (*inbijaas*), and “انْفِجَارٌ” (*infijaar*) is a common condition. But the Quran has used both words to mean the same thing.

According to *Ibn Faris* the basic meaning of “الْبَحْثُ” (*al-bahs*) is to look for something in the dirt, or to scratch the earth.

“الْبَحَاثَةُ” (*al-bohasa*) is dust or mud which has been scratched out of the ground.

“الْبَحْوُ” (*al-bohos*) is a camel which kicks up dust with his feet behind him, which it digs out while running.

“الْبَحْثُ” (*al-bahso*) is the mine in which gold or silver is prospected. {M}

Surah *Al-Maidah* mentions:

5:31	a crow was scratching the earth	عُرَابًا يَبْحَثُ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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“الْبَحِيثُ” (*al-bahees*): a secret.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that words in which “باء” (*ba*) and “حاء” (*ha*) appear together, carry the connotation of investigation, or to take out (make out) one thing of the other.

B-H-R ب ح ر

“الْبَحْرُ” (*al-bahr*): to split, or tear on a large scale. Seas or rivers are called “بَحْرٌ” (*bahr*) because they have apparently been dug into the earth. The female camel which had given birth to ten camels was let to roam freely in the name of the idols after splitting its ears, and was called “بَحِيرَةٌ” (*baheera*).

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that words in which “باء” (*ba*) and “حاء” (*ha*) appear together carry the connotation of investigation, or to take one thing out of the other.

Ibn Faris, with reference to **Khalil**, says that the sea is called “بَحْرٌ” (*bahr*) because of its vastness. A river which flows continuously is also called “*bahr*”. The sea is called “بَحْرٌ كَبِيرٌ” (*bahr kabeer*) or bigger *bahr* in comparison.

Kitabul Ashqaaq says that a great body of water (whether brackish or drinkable) is called “بَحْرٌ” (*bahr*). “بَحْرٌ” (*bahr*) actually means the place where a lot of water has accumulated. Cultivable land is also called “بَحْرٌ” (*bahr*), as well as cities, especially the cities which are situated near sea or rivers.

Quran says:

30:41	Those societies which exist on land and those which exist on <i>bahr</i> , all have become inequitable	ظَهَرَ الْفَسَادُ فِي الْبَرِّ وَالْبَحْرِ
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It also means that all societies of the world on land and water have been infested with vile.

In the meaning of land and water (the sea and dry land) these words have appeared in 17: 67. Also see heading (*Y-M-M*).

In the tale about **Moosa** crossing the river, and the Pharaoh's drowning, the words “بَحْرٌ” (*bahr*) and “يَمٌ” (*yum*) have been used in 2:50, 2:77 and 2:78.

The Quran has termed fishing as permitted:

5:96	That (fish) which you catch yourself and that which the water throws out or that is left behind on the land when the water recedes	صِيدَ الْبَحْرِ وَطَعَامُهُ
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Also see heading (*Th-Ain-M*).

B-Kh-S ب خ س

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is of shortcoming or reduction.

“الْبَخْسُ” (*al-bakhs*): to reduce, to oppress, reduction in rights. That is why **Ibnul Sakeet** says that “بَخْسٌ” (*bakhs*): to grant less than what is rightful, that is, reduction in rights {*T*}.

“الْبَاخِسُ” (*al-bakhis*): something that is slightly bad {*R*}.

“الْبَخْسُ” (*al-bakhs*) is the tax received by the ruler {*T*}.

Surah **Al-Baqarah** says:

2:282	and makes no reduction whatsoever in it	وَلَا يَبْخَسُ مِنْهُ شَيْئًا
72:13	he will not fear reduction of his rights, nor will he fear any oppression	فَلَا يَخَافُ يَخْسًا وَلَا رَهَقًا
12:20	(they) sold him for a low price	شَرَوْهُ بِثَمَنٍ بَخْسٍ

But **Zajaj** says that verse 12:20 means that the act of selling him was equal of exceeding human rights, because selling humans is forbidden.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan says that words where “باء” (*ba*) and “حاء” (*kha*) appear together give the meaning of knocking out someone’s eye, which gives a sense of committing excess.

B-Kh-Ain ب خ ع

“الْبِخَاغُ” (*al-bikha*) is a vein inside the back of the neck.

“بَخَعَ بِالشَّاةِ” (*bakha’a bish shaat*): he cut the goat’s throat with such vigour that even its “بِخَاغُ” (*bikha*) was cut through. This is the real meaning. Later it was used to mean other things too.

“بَخَعَ نَفْسَهُ يَبْخَعُ” (*bakha’a nafsahu*) is to kill oneself in anger and sorrow, (in frustration).

“بَخَعَ الْأَرْضَ بِالزَّرَاعَةِ” (*bakha’al arda biz zira’a*): he kept on tilling the soil till it lost its fertility completely.

About the Messenger, the Quran has said:

18:6	you will kill yourself (in the grief as to why these people do not believe).	لَعَلَّكَ بِاِحْتِنَافِكَ عَلَىٰ آثَارِهِمْ
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Note how a preacher of God grieves for his nation, like a kind physician.

B-Kh-L ب خ ل

“الْبُخْلُ” (*al-bukhl*): to stop the justified use of things that you have acquired.

Raghib thinks that there are two types of “بخل” (*bukhl*). One is to be miserly with what one has acquired, i.e. abstain when spending is needed. The second kind is the one who is pained to see someone else spending what he has acquired when needed. This is more condemnable. Then he presents 4:37 in support of his contention.

Muheet says that “بخل” (*bukhl*): to stop things from being spent, and “شُّحَّاسٌ” (*shohas*) is the desire which forces one to do just that. In other words, “شُّحَّاسٌ” (*shohas*) indicates both greed and “بخل” (*bukhl*).

Quran says:

4:37	the people who stop <i>rizq</i> (sustenance or wealth) from being spent and order others to desist from spending (life’s accoutrements, or necessities), and hide whatever Allah has endowed them with ...	الَّذِينَ يَبْخُلُونَ وَيَأْمُرُونَ النَّاسَ بِالْبُخْلِ وَيَكْتُمُونَ مَا أَنۡهٰهُمُ اللّٰهُ مِنْ قَضٰیهِ
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The central idea of the noble Quran is that man should strive up to his utmost, but keep only what he needs. The rest should be kept open and available for sustenance of all mankind.
See heading (N-F-Q).

“بُخْلٌ” (*bukhl*) or “miserliness” is the exact opposite of the teaching in which Man keeps everything for himself and doesn’t give anything to others. This way he denies the happiness and equities in society. (92:6 – 92:9). Quran stresses “إِنْفَاقٌ” (*infaaq*) (spending for others’ benefit) and discourages “بُخْلٌ” (*bukhl*) (miserliness) in several ways.

Islam’s basic teaching includes keeping one’s fruits of labor (after fulfilling one’s bare needs) available to others, and for spending according to Allah’s dictum. This is called *taqwa*. It solves life’s problems and makes the life of the Hereafter better. The Quran clearly states that a nation which adopts “بُخْلٌ” (*bukhl*) or miserliness as a trait is removed from the chessboard of life and replaced by another nation, which is not like the one removed (47:38).

That is because the unchangeable law of Allah is that:

13:17	Only those things are long lasting in this world, that are beneficial for mankind	مَا يَنْفَعُ النَّاسَ فَيَمْكُثُ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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The system which is for the good of only one individual, one group, or one nation, and not for the entire humanity, will not have a long-lasting effect. When something is stopped from being beneficial to Mankind, it is “بُخْلٌ” (*bukhl*) and that will create havoc for individuals as well as for nations.

B-D-A

ب د أ

“بَدَأَ” (*badabih*), “بَدَأُوا بَدَأًا” (*bad-unwa’atda’a*): to begin with something.
 “بَدَأَ الشَّيْءَ” (*bada aash shaiyi*): He initiated this, he started it.
 “فَلَا تَمَّايِدِي وَمَا يَعِيْدُ” (*fulan ma yubdiyo wama yu eed*): that man neither initiates talk nor answers anything.
 “الْبَدِي” (*al-badi*): the head man, the leader or chief.
 “بَدَأَ مِنْ أَرْضِهِ إِلَى أُخْرَى” (*bada min ardehi ila ukhra*) He left his own land for another. He left his country.
 “الْبَدَاءُ” (*al-bad-u*), “الْإِبْدَاءُ” (*al-ibda’a*): to give priority to something over basic things {*T*}.
 “بَادِي الرَّأْيِ” (*baadi ar rayee*) is the initial opinion.
 “بَادِي الرَّأْيِ” (*baadiar rayee*) is an opinion that is obvious {*R*}. See heading (B-D-W).

The Quran says:

9:13	They are the ones who began (to fight) with you. (they are the initiators)	وَهُمْ بَدَءُوا وَكُنَّ أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ
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In the context of the creation of the universe, Quran mention:

10:4	He is the One who initiates (the creations) and keeps them revolving	إِنَّهُ يَبْدَأُ الْخَلْقَ ثُمَّ يُعِيدُهُ
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It is obvious that everything gets created from the point of its initiation, and then passes through different stages to its completion. Its initiation is according to Allah's laws and its completion after different stages is also according to His laws. Also see headings (F-Th-R), (B-D-Ain), (Ain-W-D).

Surah *Saba* says:

34:49	Tell them that the constructive Allah's law is here and no destructive program can stand against it, because a destructive program doesn't have the acumen to begin any scheme and then take it to completion	قُلْ جَاءَ الْحَقُّ وَمَا يُبْدِيُ الْبَاطِلُ وَمَا يُعِيدُ
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Baatil (Untruth) does not do anything which is result-oriented.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:27	Immature opinion	بَادِي الرَّأْيِ
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For this, see heading (B-D-W).

“بَادَرَهُ” (*baadara*), “مُبَادَرَهُ” (*mubaadarah*), “بِدَارًا” (*bidara*): all these words mean to hurry about some work which is to one’s liking.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:6	being a spendthrift in a hurry	إِسْرَافًا وَ يَدَارًا
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Zajaj says it means to fill up or be completely filled.

“مُبَادَرَةً” (*muBadratun*) is a man who uses all his strength in a hurry {T}.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings

- 1) for something to be complete and filled to the brim
- 2) to rush towards something.

“الْبَدْرُ” (*al-badr*): a full moon, fully grown. Besides this “بَدْرُ” (*badr*) is the name of a place between *Mecca* and *Madina*, as described in 3:123 {T}. This was the place of a battle with the opponents.

Raghib thinks that the root of this word actually is “الْبَدْرُ” (*al-badr*) i.e. full moon.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that in words where “باء” (*ba*) and “دال” (*daal*) appear together, they give the sense of beginning, or advent.

“بَدَرَ إِلَيْهِ بِكَذَا” (*Badra ilaihi bikaziba*): that he disclosed a thing to him {K}.

This makes the meaning of “الْبَدْرُ” (*al-badr*) clear i.e. complete advent or appearance.

Ibn Faris says that “الْبَدْعُ” (*al-bido*) is something which has occurred for the first time and has no precedence.

“الْبَدِيعُ” (*al'badii*): a new rope which has been woven for the first time with new threads.

“رَكِيٌّ بَدِيعَةٌ” (*raki yun badiatun*) is a newly dug well {T}.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that in words where “باء” (*ba*) and “دال” (*daal*) appear together, they give the sense of beginning, or advent.

Raghib writes that “الْإِبْدَاعُ” (*al-ibda-o*): to create or give birth to something without following anybody i.e. without any example or model. And when this word is used for God, it means to create something without any tool, without any matter and without reference to time and place.

The Quran says:

2:117	He is the Originator of the Heavens and earth.	بَدِيعُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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Only God can bring something from oblivion into existence, but this quality is also reflect-able in Man, which allows him to discover and invent new things in the universe. This is the reason for human dominance over other creatures, the condition being that these inventions and discoveries will be used for the benefit of Mankind and not for human destruction. But all these inventions will be in the biological or physical world. God’s laws are for the benefit of mankind, and are contained in the Quran.

These laws will never change, because these laws were not made by Man’s intellect, instead given to him by revelation. This revelation is found in the Quran, and has reached completion. The lifestyle of Islam does not require any addition. It is complete and no addition or change is permitted. That is why the Quran has condemned *Rahbaniyat* (monasticism), as in 57:37, although while remaining within those unchangeable principals, laws that follow up can be formulated, according to the needs of the times.

About the Messenger, it is said:

46:9	Say "I am not a new <i>rasool</i> "	قُلْ مَا كُنْتُ بِدْعًا مِّنَ الرُّسُلِ
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Meaning of the above verse is at what I am presenting is not something new, and has already been presented previously by others.

B-D-L

ب د ل

“بَدَل” (*badal*), “بَدَلَ” (*bidl*), “بَدِيل” (*badeel*): all these words mean anything that replaces something else.
 “بَدَلْتُ الْخَاتَمَ بِالْخَلْقَةِ” (*bdaltal khatama bil khalqata*): I took off the ring and in its place put on a band.
 “بَدَّلْتُ الْخَاتَمَ بِالْخَلْقَةِ” (*baddaltul khatama bil khalqata*): I had the ring melted and in its place had a band.
 “تَبَدَّلَ” (*tabdeel*): for something to change form while its substance remains the same.
 “إِبْدَالٌ” (*ibdaal*): to replace one substance with another.
 “مُبَادَلَةٌ” (*mubadala*): to replace the kind of thing that was taken.
 “تَبَدَّلَ” (*tabaddal*): something underwent change.
 “تَبَدَّلَ” (*tabaddalahu wa tabaddala bi*): that something took its place, or changed it.
 “تَبَدَّلَ” (*tabdeel*) also means to change.

In the Quran, “بَدَلًا” (*badala*) has been used to mean in exchange for (remuneration, return and price) in 18:50. “بَدَّلَ” (*baddal*) has been used to denote to change one thing with another in 27:11.

Quran says:

30:30	Allah's way of creation never changes	لَا تَبْدِيلَ لِمَ خَلَقَ اللَّهُ
6:34	there is none who can change Allah's laws (neither can they be changed nor replaced)	لَا مَبْدِيلَ لِكَلِمَاتِ اللَّهِ
66:5	If he divorces you then Allah may give him better wives than you in exchange	إِنْ طَلَّقَكُنْ أَنْ يُبَدِّلَهُ أَزْوَاجًا خَيْرًا مِنْكَ
33:52	neither that you take other wives in their place	وَلَا أَنْ تَبْدَلَ بِهِنَّ
4:20	to wish to change (replace) one wife with another	إِسْتَبْدَالَ نَوْحٍ مَّكَانَ نَوْحٍ

For the change in situation of a nation, see 47:38.

B-D-N

ب د ن

“الْبَدَنُ” (*al-badan*): the body i.e. except the head, hands and legs. Although, *Azhari* says it means the entire body {T}.

Raghib says the word “بَدَنٌ” (*badan*) is used for the body as per the hulk, and according to its color.

Ibn Faris says it means a thing by itself, not its surroundings.

Quran says while talking of the Pharaoh:

10:92	Today we will preserve your body	فَالْيَوْمَ نُنَجِّيكَ بِبَدْنِكَ
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The pharaohs of ancient Egypt used to mummify their dead and they can still be seen. The pharaoh who followed *Moosa* was drowned in the river. So it was probably how his body was lost. But Quran had stated some fourteen hundred years ago that the body was retrieved from the sea and had been preserved. Therefore those mummies which have been recovered also include his mummy. Refer to Encyclopedia Britannica and also my book *Birk-e-Tour*. Although “بَدَنٌ” (*badanun*) also refers to armor because it is worn on the body {R}.

“الْبَادِنُ” (*al-baadinu*), “الْمُبَادِنُ” (*al-mubaddanu*): large and fuller bodied person.

“بَدُنٌ وَبَدَنٌ” (*baduna wa badana*): that he became fuller and bigger.

“الْبَدَنَةُ” (*al-badanatuh*), that cow or camel that was taken to slaughter, that is because those animals which were taken to *Mecca* for slaughter, were fattened. Its plural is “بُدنٌ” (*budnun*).

Quran says in surah *Al-Hajj*:

22:36	And the camels and cattle	وَالْبُدْنَ
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B-D-W

ب د و

“بَدُو” (*badwun*) and “بُدُو” (*budooun*): to appear

“أَبْدَيْتُهُ” (*abdaitahu*): I exposed it.

“بَدَاوَةُ الشَّيْءِ” (*badaawatuh shai*): the part of something that appear first.

The Quran has used “تُبْدُونَ” (*tubdona*) “you show”, in contrast to “تَكْتُمُونَ” (*tuktumona*) “you hide” in 2:33. Likewise in verse 2:71, the word “تُبْدُونَ” (*tubdona*) “you show” has come against “تُخْفُونَ” (*tukhfoo*) “you keep secret”.

In surah *An-Noor* the Quran says:

24:31	they should not display their adornments	وَلَا يَلْبِغْنَ زِينَتَهُنَّ
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“الْبَدُو” (*al-abadoo*), “الْبَادِيَّةُ” (*al baadiyatuh*), “الْبَدَاوَةُ” (*al badaawatuh*): desert or village.

“الْبَدَاوَةُ” (*al-badaawatuh*) is the urban life as opposed to village or desert life. Desert is said to be “بَادِيَّةٌ” (*baadiyatun*) because it is exposed and open, as in 12:100. {T}

In Quran “الْبَادِي” (*al-baadi*) appears in contrast to “الْعَاقِفُ” (*al a'kifu*) in verse 22:25, which means one who comes from outside.

Quran mention in surah *Hood* that opponents of *Noah* said the following to him:

11:27	We cannot see that other than those of the lower class (of our society) follow you.	مَا نَرَاكَ اتَّبَعَكَ إِلَّا الَّذِينَ هُمْ أَرَادُوا لَنَا بَادِي الرُّأْيِ
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This saying has a hidden meaning, that those who follow you have a clear appearance of being outcasts of normal standards. Their looks reveal their condition. (We have it as a phrase meaning of “first sight”).

This verse can also mean the opponents are trying to say that those people, who followed Noah, were not doing so because of their intellect but rather because of emotions.

B-Dh-R

ب ذ ر

“بَذَرْتُهُ بَذْرًا” (*bazartahu bazran*): I scattered it, separated it, spoilt it.

“الْبَذْرُ” (*al-bazru*), is the portion of seeds that is kept for sowing. From this it stands for agricultural cultivation. It is also used for the seedlings sown in a field, or the vegetables which just sprout out of the ground.

Nawab Sidique Hassan Khan has written that where “باء” (*ba*) and “ذال” (*dhal*) appear together, the words give meaning of extracting.

Ibn Faris has said that its fundamental meaning is to scatter and separate.

The fundamental meaning of “تَبْذِيرٌ” (*tabzeerun*) would be to consume the grain which was saved for sowing. It also means to habitually waste wealth, because “تَبْذِيرٌ” (*tabzeerun*) also means to separate {T}.

It is given in the Quran:

17:26-27	You should not squander wealth. Those who do so are opposition's brethren	لَا تَبْذُرْ تَبْذِيرًا إِنَّ الْمُبْذِرِينَ كَانُوا إِخْوَانَ الشَّيْطَانِ
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“بَرَأَ” (*barun*): The fundamental meaning is of separating one thing away from other dissimilar things.

“بَارَأَهُ” (*baara ahu*): that he separated and distanced himself.

“تَبَرَّأْنَا” (*tabarraanaa*): we are all separate.

“بَرِئَ الْمَرِيضُ مِنْ مَرَضِهِ” (*bareeu al-mardu min maradihi*): the patient is cured, because his illness has been separated from him.

“أَنَا بَرَاءٌ مِنْهُ” (*anaa baraaun minhu*): I am free, separate from it. I have no relation with it.

Quran says:

2:166	when the leaders will become frustrated and separate themselves from their followers ...	إِذْ تَبَرَّأَ الَّذِينَ اتَّبَعُوا مِنَ الَّذِينَ اتَّبَعُوا
9:1	This is a proclamation from Allah and His Rusool (the centre of Quranic system) that we are absolutely separate (from the polytheists of Mecca, with whom there was a treaty)	بَرَأَ اللَّهُ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ

With reference to Allah, he Quran says:

59:24	He is Allah, the creator, the separator, the formatter	هُوَ اللَّهُ الْخَالِقُ الْبَارِئُ الْمُصَوِّرُ
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All the elements in the Universe exist in harmony. When God has a scheme to create something, He rearranges various elements in a new form; this is called “خَلَقَ” (*khalqun*). See heading (*Kh-L-Q*). Then He separates it from the other elements, this is “بَرَأَ” (*baraa-atun*). The vesting is then given a new visual form. This is the attribute of “مُصَوِّرَتٌ” (*musawwireeat*). See heading (*Sd-Q-R*). Hence He is called *Baari*, *Khaaliq* and *Musawwir* in 59:24. Some maintain that this is why the creation is called “الْبَرِيَّةُ” (*al-bar ya*).

The Quran says:

98:7	Those are the best creations	أُولَئِكَ هُمْ شَرُّ الْبَرِيَّةِ
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The root of this word is “بَرِيَّةٌ” (*baryun*), and is derived from “الْبَرَى” (*al-bareey*), meaning the soil.

Nawab Sidque Hasan Khan has written that, whenever “باء” (*ba*) and “راء” (*raa*) appears together, its meaning is of revealing.

“بَرَأَ” (*barun*) is to be used when an incidence occurs, or gets revealed, as in 57:22.

“مُبَرَّرٌ” (*mubarra*) is the same as “بَرِئَ الدَّمِ” (*baree-uz-zimmatih*) which means “pure” (24:26).

“أَبْرَأَ” (*abraa-a*): to cure one from disease (3:48).

“بُرُوجُ” (*burooj*), singular of which is “بُرْجٌ” (*burj*), means the watch posts around a palace.

The same goes for watch posts that are built around a city, or a fortress. In this sense, this word can also mean a fortress, as in verse 4:78. In fact, any combination of (J-B-R) would indicate to a sense of intensity and power. {T}

Ibn Faris has said that the basic meanings include the sense of being apparent as well as protected.

The Quran says:

33:33	Stays seriously in your homes, and do not display your ornaments as you did in ignorant past days.	وَقَرْنَ فِي بُيُوتِكُنَّ وَلَا تَبَرَّجْنَ تَبَرُّجَ الْجَاهِلِيَّةِ الْأُولَى
24:60	Those who do not display their ornaments	غَيْرِ مُتَّبَرِّجَاتٍ بِزِينَةٍ

According to *Taj-ul-uroos*, “تَبَرَّجَ” (*tabarraja*) means a woman who displays her pride and beauty in front of men in such a manner as if she intends to tease them.

Nawab Sidque Hassan Khan has written that whenever “باء” (*ba*) and “راء” (*raa*) appears together, its meaning is of “revealing”.

Abu-ishaq has claimed that “تَبَرَّجَ” (*tabarraja*) is used when a women display herself in such a manner that it would arouse men.

The compiler of *Muheet* says that “الْبَرَّجُ” (*al-barrojo*): to walk with a hip movement, while “الْبَرَّجُ” (*al-baraju*): someone with a pretty face and “الْأَبْرَجُ” (*al-abraju*): someone with lovely eyes.

Raghib says that “تَبَرَّجَ” (*tabarruju*) can be used for a woman who comes out of her mansion and reveals herself. This confirms the understanding of above-mentioned verse (33:33).

But according to me, the meaning presented by *abu Ishaq* makes more sense, which it, means to “present oneself in such a manner that it would be the cause of male arousal”.

The human feelings of arousal do not get triggered automatically. They get activated by human thoughts and actions. The Quran teaches how to prevent such emotions. All the rules and regulations between man and woman that have been presented are to achieve this goal.

“بُرْجٌ” (*burj*) also means the star constellations. In early astronomy, the night sky was divided into 12 different star constellations. *Ibn Darid* writes in his book that the Arabs were not familiar with these constellations. In the early texts of the Arabs, one does find mention of the different stages of the moon, but nothing regarding star constellations. Hence, when the Quran addressed them with these wordings, the meaning was not star constellations, but rather stars and planets.

Quran says in surah *Al-Hijr*:

16:15	And certainly We have created <i>burooj</i> in the heaven, and made them attractive for the spectaculars.	وَلَقَدْ جَعَلْنَا فِي السَّمَاءِ بُرُوجًا وَزَيَّنَّاهَا لِلنَّاظِرِينَ
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Here the word *burooj* means huge stars which are more prominent than others.

In Surah *As-Safaat*, the Quran says:

37:6	Indeed We adorned the near sky with adornment of stars	إِنَّ زَيْنًا السَّمَاءِ الدُّنْيَا بِزِينَةِ الْكَوَاكِبِ
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From this we can conclude that Quran uses the word “بُرُوجُ” (*burooj*) for stars.

“الْبَرَّاحُ” (*al-barahu*) is the open landscape where there are no trees, vegetation or buildings in sight. Hence this word is used for such a matter in which there is no uncertainty, but which is clear and open.

“لَا بَرَّاحَ” (*labaraha*): something in which there is no doubt or uncertainty.

“بَرَّحَ الْخَفَاءُ” (*bariha-lkhafa*): that the secret got out and was revealed {T}.

Nawab Sidque Hassan Khan has written that, whenever “باء” (*ba*) and “راء” (*raa*) appears together, its meaning is of revealing. This supports the translation of “بَرَّحَ الْخَفَاءُ” (*bariha-lkhafa*) as presented above.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meanings of this root are:

- To appear, come forth, get open.
- Be heavy and big.

Raghib says that “لَا بَرَّاحَ” (*labaraha*) is used to indicate something that remains steadfast, or something that keep on working continuously.

Muheet has said that “بَرَّحَى” (*baroha*) is a word used when the aim is missed. Hence “الْبَارِحُ مِنَ الظِّبَاءِ” (*albariho minatiba i dattayr*): that deer or bird which appears in front of a hunter in such a manner that aiming it becomes difficult {T}.

Quran has used this word for instruction and determination:

12:80	I shall never leave this land.	فَلَنْ أَبْرَحَ الْأَرْضَ
18:60	I shall not stop walking, until I reach the place where the two rivers meet.	لَا أَبْرَحُ حَتَّىٰ أَتْلُعَ بِحَمَمَ الْبَحْرَيْنِ

“الْبَرْدُ” (*al-bardu*): to be chilled. It is the opposite of hot, which is “حَرٌّ” (*harra*).

“مَاءٌ بَرْدٌ وَبَارِدٌ” (*maobarodwbarid*): cold water.

“الْبَرْدُ” (*al-bardu*): sleep.

“الْبَرْدُ” (*al-barad*): hail.

“عَيْشٌ بَارِدٌ” (*a'eshun barid*): good and balanced life.

“بَرَدَ السَّيْفُ” (*baradassef*): the sword got corroded {T}.

Raghib says that as motion is associated with “حَرٌّ” (*harran*), likewise “بَرْدٌ” (*burd*) is associated with something getting motionless. For instance “بَرَدَ عَلَيْهِ دَيْنٌ” (*barada aliahi deen*) means “that load stayed with him”, that is, “did not get paid off” {T}.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root also includes the concepts of being at rest and without motion.

The Quran mention the following verse with regards to narration of **Ibrahim**.

21:69	O fire, become cold and secure Ibrahim .	يَا نَارُ كُونِي بَرْدًا وَسَلَامًا عَلَىٰ إِبْرَاهِيمَ
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This means that the opposition plotted their best efforts towards **Ibrahim**, and went neck on neck in their resistance. But the All-mighty protected **Ibrahim** against their fury, and extracted him safely from there, so he could migrate to another land.

29:24	But Allah saved him from the fire	فَأَنجَاهُ اللَّهُ مِنَ النَّارِ
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Above verse means that the opposition even plotted to burn him alive, but Allah failed their conspiracies and extracted **Ibrahim** to safety. Also se 37:97-99.

21:70	They planned a plot against him, but We made them to lose.	وَأَرَادُوا بِهِ كَيْدًا فَجَعَلْنَاهُمُ الْأَخْسَرِينَ
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In other words, their plot did not bear any fruit. **Ibrahim** migrated safely from there to someplace else. Also see 29:26, 21:71 and 39:99.

From all these points, it is obvious that the word fire reflects the furious rivalry of the opposition, which Allah cooled down, so they could not fulfil their hateful plans.

With regards to the meaning of “hail rain”, this word has been used in verse 24:43.

Surah **Al-Waqiah** says following when explaining the restrictions or punishment of **Jahannum**.

56:44	Not cooling, not pleasant nor beneficial.	لَا تَارِدٌ وَلَا يَكْرِيمٌ
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Surah **An-naba** says the following with regards to those in **Jahannum**:

78:24	They shall not find cool and anything to drink	لَا يَذُوقُونَ فِيهَا بَرْدًا وَلَا شَرَابًا
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Taj-ul-Uroos says that the meaning of “بَرْدٌ” (**barud**) in the above verse is “sleep”. The compiler of **kitab-ul-ashfaaq** has also supported this opinion. This word could also be used for “relaxation” and “ease”, which are most suitable here. As the saying goes “no relaxation in punishment”.

Ibn Faris has said that the basic meaning includes a sense of anxiety and motion.

B-R-R

ب ر ر

“بَرَر” (**barar**): vastness, broadness etc. because “بَرٌّ” (**berr**) has been used against “بَحْرٌ” (**bahar**). Since we use “بَحْرٌ” (**bahar**) to define sea or river, “بَرٌّ” (**berr**) against that denotes dry land, as in 17:67.

“الْبَرُّ” (**al-berr**): desolate land and “بَحْرٌ” (**bahar**): such places and cities which have water. “بَرٌّ” (**berr**) also means to drive goat or sheep. Since it means vastness, it has come to mean extensive. As such “أَبَرَّ الرَّجُلُ” (**abarar rajul**): that man became a man with many children.

“أَبَرَّ الْقَوْمَ” (**abarar qaum**): a nation that has expanded greatly. Because of this, this word also got to be used for dominance.

“أَبَرَّ عَلَيْهِمُ” (**abarar alaihim**): that he excelled them, and overwhelmed them.

“الْمُبِرُّ” (**ilmubirr**): someone who gains dominance.

Nawab Sidque Hassan Khan has written that whenever “باء” (**ba**) and “راء” (**ra**) appears together in a word, its meaning is of “revealing”. This supports the translation of “بَرِّحَ الْخَفَاءُ” (**barihalkhafa**) as presented above.

With regards to this, “بَرٌّ” (**berr**) also means “he appeared”. Being liberal in vision, greatness of heart, lend “بَرٌّ” (**berr**) to the meaning of good behaviour, kindness and sympathy on a grand scale. It also means truth and obedience.

“بَرُّ” (**berru**) and “بِرٌّ” (**birru**): someone who is true to his promise.

“الْبَرُّ” (**al-berru**) is also one of God’s attributes as defined in 52:28.

Quran has used “بِرٌّ” (**birru**) against “إِسْمٌ” (**ism**) in 5:2

“إِسْمٌ” (**ism**): weakness, tiredness. As such, “بَرٌّ” (**berr**) being the opposite would mean strength, vastness, proliferation, expanse, broadness. Since “إِسْمٌ” (**ism**) is a crime, “بِرٌّ” (**birru**) is virtue. As such, according to the Quran, virtuous deeds will be those who open the way for expansion, produce broader vision, expansion in the heart and greatness in the human character, and overall which produces expansion in life’s accoutrements. And to be expansive in different matters “بِرٌّ” (**birru**) and “تَقْوَىٰ” (**taqwa**) have thus been used together in 5:2 and 2:224, because with “تَقْوَىٰ” (**taqwa**) (observance of Allah’s laws) man is distanced from narrow-mindedness and moves towards expansion. That can be achieved by Man keeping

his dearest possessions (wealth, or even one's life) available according to Allah's laws, for the benefit of mankind.

It is therefore said:

3:91	until you keep your dearest possessions open for humans, you will not achieve extensiveness and broadness	لَنْ تَنَالُوا الْبِرَّ حَتَّى تُنْفِقُوا مِمَّا حُبِبْتُمْ
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Those who think that to observe religious dictums only superficially constitutes “*بِرٌّ*” (*berr*), or virtue, are grossly mistaken.

Quran clearly says:

2:177	Greatness cannot be achieved by turning your faces in directions of east or west.	لَيْسَ الْبِرُّ أَنْ تُولُؤُوا وُجُوهَكُمْ قِبَلَ الْمَشْرِقِ وَالْمَغْرِبِ
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The process to reach greatness is that you, after endorsing *belief*, make your wealth available for needy people of your society, despite its attractions. Those who follow this process are called “*أَبْرَارٌ*” (*abrar*) against “*فُجَّارٌ*” (*fujjar*) which means wrongdoers in 82:11-12, and also “*بِرَّةٌ*” (*bararah*) in 80:16.

About *Yahya* it is said:

19:14	he used to deal with his parents with broad heartedness (kindly)	بِرًّا يُولَدِيهِ
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God has been called “*الْبَرُّ الرَّحِيمُ*” (*al-berrur Rahim*) in 52:28, which means the expander, provider of growth. He has provided (various things) for humanity on such a large scale that nobody can ever doubt about Him being the Provider. As such, a society that reflects upon their God's attributes, may as well, within the limits of humanity, also be “*الْبَرُّ الرَّحِيمُ*” (*al-berrur Rahim*). In other words, the society must be generous and great for the provision of the human race. This is the definition of “*بِرٌّ*” (*birr*) which is commonly translated as virtue. Generally speaking, it is obvious that this word “virtue” cannot have the connotation of greatness and vastness. A virtuous person is one who avoids bad deeds. But to avoid bad deeds, is but a negative aspect. The Quran also demands positivity with it. Therefore, according to the Quran, a nation which is not open hearted and generous, and does not provide for the human race with their generosity, cannot possess “*بِرٌّ*” (*birr*).

B-R-Z ب ر ز

“*الْبَرَّازُ*” (*al-baraz*) or “*الْبِرَّازُ*” (*al-biraz*): a vast expanse with no vegetation etc. Since people in early days used to go to open places for defecating, “*الْبِرَّازُ*” (*al-biraz*) and “*الْبَرَّازُ*” (*al-baraz*) came to mean the loo.

“*بَرَزَ*” (*baraz*): to become evident, to appear.

“*الْبَارِزُ*” (*al-bariz*) is the thing which has appeared completely.

Nawab Sidque Hassan Khan has written that, whenever “*باء*” (*ba*) and “*راء*” (*ra*) appears together in a word, its meaning is of appearing or revealing.

Ibn Faris writes that its fundamental meaning is to be apparent and to distinguish oneself from other similar things.

“*بَارَزَ مُبَارَزةً*” (*baraza mubarazah*) is the battlefield, where men come forth face to face, by leaving the rows of soldiers.

“*بَرَزَ*” (*baraz*) is to exceed others in bravery, and come forth. {T}

The Quran says:

2:250	When they came forth to face <i>Jaloot</i> (in combat).	وَلَمَّا بَرَزُوا لِجَالُوتَ
18:47	you will note that the land is open (or those who have been subdued will rise and appear)	وَتَرَى الْأَرْضَ بَارِزةً

14:21	All, big and small, will appear before Allah (Before His law of consequences)	وَبَرَزُوا لِلَّهِ جَمِيعًا
40:16	nothing they do is hidden from Allah (His laws)	لَا يَخْفَى عَلَى اللَّهِ مِنْهُمْ شَيْءٌ

The above verse means that results of their deeds will become prominent and become apparent.

At another place it is said:

79:36	And <i>jaheem</i> will rise and become evident, for those who have insight	وَبَرَزَتِ الْجَحِيمُ
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This means that at that time the results (of their deeds) shall appear before them, but only for those who understand.

79:36	For those who have insight.	لِمَنْ يَرَىٰ
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As such, the criminals (the wrongdoers) are not oblivious of their current negative state. 82:16

29:45	And for sure, <i>Jahannum</i> surround the <i>kafireen</i>	وَأِنَّ جَهَنَّمَ لَمُحِيطَةٌ بِالْكَافِرِينَ
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But this is only obvious for those who have insight of things. This state only appears before the one who has understanding of it. For details see heading (*Jahannum*).

Barzakh برزخ

”برزخ“ (*barzakh*): the partition or limit between two things.

Raghib says it has come from ”برزقة“ (*barzah*) which means “a veil”.

Ibn Faris says this is actually an Arabic word from root (**B-R-Z**) and the ”خاء“ (*kha*) is additional and added for exaggeration. It means such vastness that has become a limit for things. In other words, things outside are too far away to be seen. Here too it would mean a partition, which obstructs vision.

Surah *Rahman* says:

55:20	there is a partition between the two rivers, beyond which they cannot proceed	بَيْنَهُمَا بَرْزَخًا لَا يَبْغِيَانِ
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Also see 25:35. Surah *Momineen* says that when one of them dies then he says “O God, if you would return me back to the world, I will do good deeds”. But the Quran says that such requests are meaningless, because no one can return to this world once he has died:

33:99 33:100	they have a partition behind them, till the time of the Rising	وَمِنْ وَرَائِهِمْ بَرْزَخًا إِلَىٰ يَوْمِ يُبْعَثُونَ
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See headings (*W-R-Y*) and (*B-Ain-Th*).

B-R-Sd ب ر ص

”الْبَرَصُ“ (*al-baras*): the white spot which appears on one's body due to some disease, such as leprosy.

”الْبَرَاصُ“ (*al-biraas*) is desert lands which do not have any cultivation; barren land {*F*}.

”تَبَرَّصَ الْبَعِيرُ الْأَرْضَ“ (*tabarrasal ba'eerul ard*): the camel grazed all the grass, and didn't leave anything on ground {*T*}.

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* relates what *Isa* (Jesus) told his people:

3:48	I will give sight to those who are born blind and relieve a leper of his disease	وَأُبْرِئُ الْأَكْمَةَ وَالْأَبْرَصَ
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The condition of **Bani Israel** (the descendants of Israel) has been compared to that of lepers. It means either that their land was absolutely barren or that they roamed hither and thither, while nobody was ready to own them.

3:111	wherever they go, they will be met with insult and demeaning behaviour	وَضُرِبَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ الذِّلَّةُ أَيْنَ مَا تَقْتُمُوا
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Both meanings have the same concept. The main duty of a Messenger is in fact to liberate a nation from their state of deamination and to make its barren land fertile.

The Quran has equated moral deficiencies with diseases and referring to such people thus:

2:17	deaf, mute, blind	صُمٌّ بُكْمٌ عُمْيٌ
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It has also been said that such people carry diseases in their hearts:

2:10	There are diseases in their hearts	فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ مَرَضٌ
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They have even been called “dead” in 27:80. In this context celestial teachings are called “هُدًى وَشِفَاءٌ” (*hudawn wa shifa*) as in 41:44, which says that this guidance is a cure.

10:57	cure for whatever they have in their hearts	شِفَاءٌ لِّمَا فِي الصُّدُورِ
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The purpose for the advent and mission of the messengers is not to cure bodily diseases but to remove the “diseases of humanity”. To grant vision to the blind and to cure the lepers is also an allegory as used in the case of *Isa*. See details in my book “*Shola-e-Mastoor*”.

B-R-Q ب ر ق

“بَرْقٌ” (*barq*) is the lightning in the sky. It basically means “flash”.

“بَرْقٌ بَصَرُهُ” (*bariqa basaroon*): that his eyes got blind sighted because of light, and due to the surprise and fear, he couldn’t see (75:7).

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be surprised.

Surah *Al-Baqarah* says:

2:20	The lightning nearly snatched away their vision.	يَكَادُ الْبَرْقُ يَخْطَفُ أَبْصَارَهُمْ
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“إِسْتَبْرَقٌ” (*istabraq*): thick silken cloth (18:31, 55:54) {*T, M*}.

“إِبْرَيْقٌ” (*ibreeq*): a pouring pot, jug or such vessel. 56:18. This is supposed to be the Arabic form of the Persian word “آب ریز” (*aab’rez*) {*L*}

But *Ibn Faris* says that this word is derived from the word “برق” (*barq*) and it means something beautiful and shiny.

“بَرَكَه” (*barakah*): stability with growth. In other words, it is something which is established in its origin and keeps growing at the same time. Hence the meaning includes concepts of stability and abundance, as well as development.

Nawab Siddiq Hassan Khan says that words in which “باء” (*ba*) and “راء” (*ra*) appear together give the connotation of “appearance”.

The concept of development indicates towards the exposition of one's hidden abilities. Hence “بَرَكَه” (*barka*) includes the ideas of stability, growth, development, appearance and conspicuousness.

Ibn Faris also wrote that this word means stability and growth.

“مُبَارَكٌ” (*Mubarak*) or “فِيهِ بَرَكَه” (*feehey barakah*) is said when something is felt to be growing, as well as being stable. It is derived from “بَرَكَتُ الْبَعِيرِ” (*barakal bayeer*) which means “the camel sat there with a plumb and didn't leave its place”. “الْبِرْكَة” (*al-birkah*) is “the camel's chest” which it uses to support when sitting, and it also means a goat which produces a lot of milk, and also a pool or pond in which water has stagnated {*R, M, T*}.

The plural for “بَرَكَه” (*barakah*) is “بَرَكَاتٌ” (*barakaat*). As mentioned earlier “بَرَكَه” (*barakah*): stability, growth and all kinds of good things. Since these things are obtained through the necessary means, therefore the means of this goodness will also be called “بَرَكَاتٌ” (*barakaath*).

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says that the necessary result of “إيمان” (*eeman*) and “تقوى” (*taqwa*) is that the nation which practices them is bestowed with “بَرَكَاتٌ” (*barakaat*):

7:96	Barakaat from the heavens and earth	بَرَكَاتٍ مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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This means that it will be endowed with the goodness of the heavens as well as the earth. This means that such a nation gets economic benefits, as well as celestial guidance.

About the earth it is said:

41:10	(God has) proliferated it with things which are the means of stability and sustenance for the humankind.	وَبَارَكْنَا فِيهَا
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Surah *Al-Qaf* says:

50:9	we made rain from the skies which is the means for growth and stability for humankind	نَزَّلْنَا مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً مُّبَارَكًا
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The Quran has also said the following about itself:

38:39	Such system of living which is a permanent source of goodness through a set of God's laws, which are directly related to the growth and nurturing of mankind.	كِتَابًا نَّزَّلْنَاهُ إِلَيْكَ مُبَارَكًا
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The night in which the Quran was revealed is also termed as “مُبَارَكٌ” (*mubarak*) in 44:2

Mecca city (the center of Islam) has also been called “مُبَارَكٌ” (*mubarak*). Due to His sustenance (*rahoobiya*) of the universes God Himself is called “مُبَارَكٌ” (*mubarak*).

7:54	Tabarik is Allah, Sustainer of worlds	تَبَارَكَ اللَّهُ رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ
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“تَبَارَكَ” (*tabaraka*): to be the fountainhead for all kinds of goodness and benevolence.

“تَبَارَكَ الَّذِي” (*tabarakal lazi*): the personality in whom goodness and benevolence has reached its ultimate.

Thus the meaning of verse 7:54 would be that the personality which is the fountainhead of all kinds of goodness and benevolence is the personality of Allah, and the entire universe is provided sustenance from this fountainhead. A nation which wants to reflect this trait of Allah must also be responsible for providing sustenance to the world.

B-R-M

ب ر م

“أَبْرَمَ الْحَبْلَ” (*abramal habal*): he wove the rope tightly (in two colors or two weaves).

“الْمَبَارِمُ” (*al-mabarim*) spinning wheel etc. on which ropes are tightened.

“الْبَرِيمُ” (*al-barim*) is a double-weaved thread which women put round their waists or arms, anything that has two colors, or rope or string with two colors.

“أَبْرَمَ الْأَمْرَ” (*ab-ramal amar*): he strengthened the matter {T}.

“قَضَاءٌ مُبْرَمٌ” (*qazaun mubrum*): solid or unchangeable decision.

The Quran says:

43:79	Have they strengthened their cause (for opposing the truth)? If so, then We too will strengthen our cause.	أَمْ أَبْرَمُوا أَمْرًا فَإِنَّا مُبْرِمُونَ
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Since a rope to be woven strongly has to be woven repeatedly, therefore “إِبْرَامُ” (*ibraam*) is also used for being dogmatic and stubborn {M}.

Ibn Faris includes following in its basic meanings

For something to be strengthened, two different colors, to be frustrated.

The word has not been used in the Quran to mean the last thing.

B-R-He

ب ر ه

“الْبَرَّةُ” (*al-barah*): plumpness along with fairness in color.

“الْبَرَارَةُ” (*al-bararah*): fair, young beauty, glowing fair and fresh skin {R}.

“الْبَرَهَةُ” (*al-barhato*), “الْبُرْهَةُ” (*al-burhaa*): longer time {T}.

“الْبُرْهَانُ” (*al-burhan*) according to *Khalil*, has come from the word “بُرْهَانَةٌ” (*barahrah*) meaning of which is given above as laminated with clear reasoning. Or that it comes from “بُرْهَةٌ” (*burhah*) which means to delink or cut, or in other words, the reasoning for dissociation or separation.

Raghib says that it has come from “بَرَّةٌ” (*bareh*) and “يَبْرَهُ” (*yabrahu*) which means “white”. {R}

Nawab Siddiq Hassan Khan says that words in which “باء” (*ba*) and “راء” (*ra*) appear together give the connotation of “appearance”.

All agree upon that it means such reasoning which is true for all times and in every situation. Clear and distinct reasoning, very evident reasoning.

The Quran has said about itself:

4:175	Distinct reasoning from your Sustainer.	بُرْهَانَيْنِ رَبِّكُمْ
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This is because every bit of reasoning of the Quran is based on claim and solid logic.

That is why it demands reasoning from its opponents and openly says:

2:111	if your claims are true then give reasoning in their support	هَآئِنِآ بُرْهَانُكُمْ إِن كُنتُمْ صَادِقِينَ
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It is so sure about its own reasoning that along with this demand, it says that they cannot have any final reasoning:

23:117	None can give any reasoning (in support of “shirk”).	لَا يُعْجِزُ لَهُ شَيْءٌ
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It is one of the particularities of the Quran to present **Deen** (which was always thought to be beyond any reasoning) with the help of knowledge, intellect and reason. It backs all its claims by solid reasoning and knowledge.

The Quran has given us **Deen** not religion. The word for **mazhab** as religion does not appear in the Quran. We have used it for general purposes. Otherwise Islam should be called a **Deen**, which means “Way of Life”, or “system of society ordained by Allah”.

B-Z-Gh ب ز غ

“بَزَغَ نَابُ الْبَعِيرِ” (*bazagha naabol ba’eer*): the camel’s molar (teeth) pierced the flesh to make itself appear. When the sun and the moon rise, they are called “بُزُوعٌ” (*buzugh*) {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for something to appear or make it evident.

“الرَّبِيعُ ابْتَزَغَ” (*ibtazaghar rabbi*): spring began, and the buds started blooming {T}.

Quran says:

6:78 6:79	The rising or shining of the sun and moon	الْقَمَرَ بَازِغًا ، الشَّمْسَ بَازِغَةً
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Nawab Siddiq Hassan Khan says that words in which “باء” (*ba*) and “زاء” (*za*) appear together give the connotation of “coming out and being evident”, and that is what “بَزَغَ” (*bazgh*) {T}.

B-S-R ب س ر

“الْبُسْرُ” (*basr*) basically means for something to act prematurely and incompletely.

“بَسَرَ الدُّمْلُ” (*basaral dumal*): he popped the blister before it became ripe.

“الْبُسْرُ” (*al-busr*): everything that is fresh, for instance a date which is not ripe {T}.

With these meanings, the Quran says:

74:23	he made a face	ثُمَّ عَبَسَ وَبَسَرَ
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“بَسَرَ” (*basar*) also means to look at someone despicably, thus it would mean raising the eyebrows and make a face. One believes that eating unripe fruit leaves distaste in the mouth. Hence “بَسَرَ” (*basar*) became to mean “distasteful”.

At another place it is said:

75:24	that day there will be some distorted faces	وُجُوهُ يُؤْمِتُهَا بَاسِرَةٌ
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Ibn Faris thinks it means:

- 1) The state of something prior to ripening (completion)
- 2) The reduction in movement of something, or for it to stop before its time.

“بَسَرَ الرَّجُلُ الْحَاجَةَ” (*basarur rajul ool haaja*): he sought to fulfill his needs in a place where they couldn’t be (fulfilled).

The powder of dry bread, which can be mixed with water, and drunk. To mix with water, to crush into a powder is called “بَسَّ يَبْسُ بَسًّا” (*bassa yaboosso bassa*). Thus it also means to reduce something into small bits or granules.

“بَسَّ الْإِبِلَ بَسًّا” (*bassan ibila bassa*): he drove the camels with kindness.

“الْبَسُّ” (*al-basso*): to send the camels into different cities and scatter them. Thus this word would mean to drive something from its place {T, R}.

“أَنْبَسَتِ الْحَيَّاتُ” (*inbassatil hayat*): that the snakes slithered quickly {T, R}.

The Quran says:

56:5	The <i>jibaa</i> (leaders of the oppressors) will be blown to smithereens. Or, they will be driven from their place and thus removed. Or, they will themselves slither away	وَبَسَّتِ الْجِبَالُ بَسًّا
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In the same meaning, it appears at different places:

78:20	And these leaders shall lose their grip and scatter.	وَسَيَرَّتِ الْجِبَالُ فَكَانَتْ سَرَابًا
81:3	When these leaders lose their grip	وَإِذَا الْجِبَالُ سُيِّرَتْ
77:10	When these leaders get crushed	وَإِذَا الْجِبَالُ نُسِفَتْ
20:105	The Sustainer shall crush them all	يَنْسِفُهَا رَبِّي نَسْفًا

At all these places the meaning is similar i.e. the breakup of their strength, all their places (status) to be lost, to be destroyed in revolution. See also heading (*N-S-F*) and (*J-B-L*). Note that *jibaa* literally means mountains. Therefore if these verses are taken literally then they would mean that “the mountains flew away or disintegrated”. But in reference to the context, the former meanings seems to be more appropriate.

“بَسَطَ” (*basatahu*), “بَسَّطَ” (*bas’atahu*) mean to spread, broadcast, to extend, to expand, as against “قَبْضُ” (*kabz*) in 2: 245, and as against “قَدَرُ” (*qadar*) in 42:27, which means to give in measured quantities. Also against “مَغْلُولَةٌ” (*maghloola*) or tied up in 5:64 and 17:29. Besides this, it also means to attack, reach out, to be high handed, as in 5:11, where it is said:

5:11	That they stretch their hands towards you.	أَنْ يَبْسُطُوا إِلَيْكُمْ أَيْدِيَهُمْ فَكَفَّ أَيْدِيَهُمْ عَنْكُمْ
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It may also mean domination, as in:

6:94	And the angels will be spreading their hands (overwhelm them)	وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ بَاسِطُوا أَيْدِيَهُمْ
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“مَبْسُوطٌ” (*mabsoot*): wide, as in 5:64

“بَسَّطَ” (*bisatun*) spread out and lay out, as in 71:19.

About *Taloot*, the Quran says:

2:247	He was given knowledge and bodily strength in abundance	زَادَهُ بَسْطَةً فِي الْعِلْمِ وَالْجِسْمِ
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Raghib says that “بَسَّطَ فِي الْعِلْمِ” (*bastatan fil ilmi*): that Man should not only benefit himself through knowledge but also be beneficial to others. And God told the Bani Israel “you employ your strengths for yourself only, but *Taloot* benefits others with his body (bodily strength) and knowledge. That is why We have selected him to be your commander”. To become a commander, one needs both bodily and mental strengths, and also the capability to benefit others with his capabilities.

”الْبَسَاقُ“ (*al-busaaq*): mouth's saliva.

”بَسَقَ“ (*basaaq*): he spat.

”بَسَقَ النَّخْلُ بُسُوْقًا“ (*basaaq nakhlo basuqa*): the date palms (grew) taller and higher. *Ibn Faris* says this is its basic meaning.

”بَسَقَ عَلَيْهِمْ“ (*basaaq alaihim*): he exceeded them in exaltation.

”الْبَسُوْقُ“ (*al-basooq*): a (female) goat with long teats.

”يَبْسُقُ الشَّيْءُ بُسُوْقًا“ (*basaaq shai-o basuqa*): the length of a thing got completed {T, R}.

The Quran says:

50:10	tall date palms	وَالنَّخْلُ بَسِيقٌ
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Muheet says it also means laden date palms.

The real meaning of ”بَسَلَ“ (*basl*) is to stop. *Raghib* has written in this context that it means to prevent. Explaining the difference between ”بَسَلَ“ (*basl*) and ”حَرَّمَ“ (*haram*), he writes that ”حَرَّمَ“ (*haram*) is general and ”بَسَلَ“ (*basl*) means to prevent with force or anger.

”يَوْمٌ بَسِيلٌ“ (*yaumun basil*): a hard day.

”الْبَاسِلُ“ (*al-basil*): a lion.

”بَسَالَةٌ“ (*basala*): brave, one who bravely defends himself {M}.

”الْبَسْلُ“ (*al-basl*): deprived, as well as that which is mortgaged with somebody {R}.

”بَسَلَالَهُ“ (*baslalah*): let him meet destruction {T}.

”الْبَسْلُ“ (*al-basl*): to screen in a sieve, or to take something a little at a time, or to imprison someone.

”أَبْسَلَهُ“ (*absalahu*): gave him up to destruction and annihilation.

”أَبْسَلَهُ لِعَمَلِهِ“ (*absalahu li `amalehi*): he was given up to his deeds (so that he gets paid for his deeds) {T}.

The Quran says:

6:70	Lest someone (due to his wrongdoings) is deprived (of Quranic blessings)	أَنْ تُبْسَلَ نَفْسٌ مِمَّا كَسَبَتْ
6:70	These are the ones who have been deprived due to their deeds	أُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ أُبْسِلُوا بِمَا كَسَبُوا

This means tasting the results of one's deeds according to the scheme of things, or to be deprived of the blessings of life and in this way stultifying of life's progress.

”بَسَمَ“ (*basam*), ”يَبْسِمُ“ (*yabsam*), ”بَسْمًا“ (*basmah*): to smile or laugh lightly to display pleasure.

”إِبْتَسَمَ“ (*ibtisim*), ”تَبَسَّمَ“ (*tabassam*): he laughed briefly but beautifully, or smiled.

”مَا بَسَمْتُ فِي الشَّيْءِ“ (*ma basamto fee shaiyi*): I have not even tasted it.

27:19	he smiled due to pleasure	فَتَبَسَّمَ ضَاحِكًا
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“بَشْرَةٌ” (*bashara*): the upper surface of a man’s skin. As such “الْبَشْرُ” (*al-bashar*) means to strip the skin, i.e. to clear it of hair {T}. Later “الْبَشِيرُ” (*al-basher*) came to mean man himself with the difference that “بَشِيرٌ” (*bashar*) means only the physical part of a human being. This way, every human child or human being is a “بَشِيرٌ” (*bashar*), but the ingredients (elements) of humanness would be different in each human being.

Thus the Quran says about the Messenger:

18:110	(Tell them) I too am a (<i>bashar</i>) human like you all	أَنَا بَشَرٌ مِّثْلُكُمْ
23:33	(They said that) this messenger is a (<i>bashar</i>) human just like you. Whatever you eat, he eats too. Whatever you drink, he drinks too	مَا هَذَا إِلَّا بَشَرٌ مِّثْلُكُمْ يَا كُفَّارٌ مَا تَأْكُلُونَ مِنْهُ وَيَشْرَبُ مِمَّا تَشْرَبُونَ

If celestial guidance which he receives from God is separated from him, then the physical being of a messenger is like ordinary human beings, but messenger-hood could not be acquired by human endeavor.

The human part of a messenger may end with his death but the revelation part remains. Generally, “إِنْسَانٌ” (*insaan*) and “بَشِيرٌ” (*basher*) have been used as alternates (15:26, 15:28).

“بَاشِرًا” (*baashraha*): copulation in such a way that the skin of man and woman is in contact (2:187). Sometimes it means only necking and kissing {T}, but the Quran uses “بَاشِرُونَ” (*basheru hunna*) in 2:187 for sexual relations.

“بِشَارَةٌ” (*bishara*) basically means tidings which change the color of a man’s face, regardless of the news being unpleasant or pleasant.

“بَشَارًا” (*basharra*): to impart such news.

The Quran uses this word for news of a great punishment (3:20). Similarly in surah *An-Nahal* it is said that when they are told about a girl child being born to them, their faces turn black (due to sadness). For such news too, the word “بَشِيرٌ” (*bashar*) has been used (16:58), but ordinarily “بِشَارَةٌ” (*bisharah*) means good news.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this word is to appear with beauty.

“أَبْشَرَ” (*abshara*) and “إِسْتَبَشَرَ” (*istabshara*) also mean to be happy.

Surah *Az-Zomr* uses “إِسْتَبَشَارٌ” (*istibshaar*) as against “إِشْمِيزَازٌ” (*ishmezaaz*) (39:45).

“الْبِشَارَةُ” (*al-basharah*) also means beauty.

“الْبَشِيرُ” (*al-basheero*): one who brings good news.

“الْبِشْرُ” (*al-bishr*): large heartedness.

“الْتَبَاشِيرُ” (*at-tabashir*): good news, as well as the front part or the initial part of anything. It also means the first rays of the sun in the morning.

“الْمُبَشِّرَاتُ” (*al-mubash-sheraat*): those winds which bring tidings of rain.

The Quran has used “بَشِيرٌ” (*basher*) and “نَذِيرٌ” (*nazeer*) for the messengers in 5:19.

“بَشِيرٌ” (*basheer*) means he who gives good news about happy results of good deeds.

“نَذِيرٌ” (*nazeer*) is he who warns of the destructive results of traversing the wrong path.

In verse 17:105 “بَشِيرٌ” (*bashar*) has also been used along with “نَذِيرٌ” (*nazeer*). This too means one who gives good news.

“بَصَرَ” (*basar*): to touch the heart, that is why it also means “knowledge”.

“بَصِيرٌ” (*baseer*): one who sees, and also a scholar:

“بَصِيرَةٌ” (*baseerah*): power of comprehension, or intellect. It also means reasoning, faith and intent.

“بَصِيرَةٌ” (*baseerah*) also means witness and testifier {T}.

“بَصِيرَةٌ” (*baseerah*): a spot of blood or blood mark to identify the prey.

“بَصْرَةٌ” (*basarah*): hard ground and also soft and white stone {T}. *Raghib* has added “shinning” to its meaning as well.

The Quran has used this root to mean easy to comprehend. Surah *Airaaf* says:

7:195	Do they not have eyes with which they may see?	أَمْ لَهُمْ آغْيُنٌ يُبْصِرُونَ بِهَا
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Quran has used “أَعْمَى” (*a’amaa*) (blind) as against “بَصِيرٌ” (*baser*) (one who can see) in 20:125. The difference between sight or vision and insight has also been made very clear.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:198	You can see that they have their eyes towards you, but they are not actually seeing (grasping the meaning or truth).	وَتَرَاهُمْ يُنْظَرُونَ إِلَيْكَ وَهُمْ لَا يُبْصِرُونَ
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Such people have been called “” (*umyun*) or blind in surah *Yunus* (Jonah). Those who don’t use their insight or “بَصِيرَتٌ” (*baseerat*) 10:43. In 47:16, these people have been mentioned by saying that they are (apparently) listening to you, but in fact are lost in some other thought {R, T}. Also see heading (S-M-Ain)

Having “بَصِيرَةٌ” (*baseerah*) or insight means to utilize the directions given in to revelation with one’s intelligence. This has been made clear in 6:50 {T}. *Momins* are those who possess “بَصِيرَةٌ” (*baseerat*) i.e. who employ their intellect in the light of the revelation.

The Quran uses “بَصِيرَةٌ” (*baseerah*) to mean witness in 75:14 and “مُبْصِرَةٌ” (*mubassirah*): the one who is illuminating and presenting clear reasoning.

The word “بَصِيرًا” (*baseerah*) has also been used in surah *Yusuf* 12:66. The Quran has called itself “بَصَائِرُ” (*basa-ir*) in 6:105 where the meaning is of being distinct reasoning, open truth, illumination of knowledge.

“إِسْتَبْصَرَ الشَّيْءَ” (*istabsharash shaiyi*): saw something very closely {T, M}.

Raghib has said that “إِسْتَبْصَرَ” (*istabsar*) means to ask for insight.

“أَبْصَرَ” (*absar*) also means this, i.e. “to see”.

The Quran says:

29:38	they had insight and were wise and perceiving	وَكَانُوا مُسْتَبْصِرِينَ
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The Quran has said that the nations of *Aad* and *Samood* despite possessing intellect and insight were destroyed. At another place this has been explained by saying:

46:26	We had granted them the power to hear, see, and think (deliberate).	وَجَعَلْنَا لَهُمْ سَمْعًا وَ أَبْصَارًا وَ أَفْئِدَةً
46:26	but since they were rebellious of God’s laws, their hearing, or sight or insight could do them no good and they were destroyed	فَمَا أَغْنَى عَنْهُمْ سَمْعُهُمْ وَلَا أَبْصَارُهُمْ وَلَا أَفْئِدَتُهُمْ مِنْ شَيْءٍ إِذْ كَانُوا يَجْحَدُونَ بِآيَاتِ اللَّهِ

The Quran has said that if intellect is not made subservient to celestial guidance then it cannot protect man from annihilation. Let's see how man's intellect works. Man is born with animal instincts in him. These create different kinds of desires in him. If his life is dominated by the intellect and emotions (without the guidance of the revelation). Then his intellect will try to justify these desires and try to satisfy the desires some way. Thus that desire will turn into a wish, and when man decides to satisfy that wish then it will turn into a will. Man's intellect will thus be a means to satisfying his desire.

If the intellect is mature, then it might try to expostulate to man how harmful the satisfaction of that desire may be, i.e. intellect can at the most protect only self interests. It can go no further. Intellect cannot distinguish between what is wrong and right. This is possible only for the celestial guidance, which is the last word on the universal good or bad for the entire mankind and also for the strength and weakness of a man himself. Therefore man can avoid destruction only if he employs the intellect under the guidance of the celestial guidance.

Today, the big nations of the world are on the brink of disaster, because they do not put their intellect under the guidance of the revelation. And we, the muslims, are in ignominy because we are neither invoking the celestial guidance nor using our intellect.

B-Sd-L ب ص ل

“بَصَلٌ” (*basal*): “onion” {*T*}. In the noble Quran, this word has appeared in verse 2:61

B-Zd-Ain ب ض ع

“الْبِضْعُ” (*al-baz'o*): to cut.
 “بَضَعْتُ اللَّحْمَ” (*bazaatul laham*): I cut the meat into pieces.
 “الْبِزْءُ” (*al-biz'o*): a part, some part {*R, T*}.

The Quran says:

12:42	some years	بِضْعٍ سِنِينَ
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But it is used for more than three years, and less than ten {*R, T*}.

“الْبِضَاعَةُ” (*al-biza'ah*) is that part of the wealth which is used for business {*R, T*}. The goods for trading. Surah *Yusuf* uses these words in this meaning:

12:19	they hid him as goods to be traded	وَأَسْرَوْهُ بِضَاعَةً
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“بِضَاعَتُهُمْ” (*biza'atahoom*): capital, as in 12:62, and 12:65.

B-Te-A ب ط أ

“بَطُو” (*bat'u*), “يَبْطُو” (*yabtu'u*), “بِطَاءٌ” (*beta'aa*) is to delay.
 “أَبْطُوا” (*abatu*): their animals became slow.

Raghib says “الْبَطُو” (*al-batoo*): to slack (delay) in coming along, or in getting up (to go). He translates this verse from surah *An-Nisa*:

4:72	Those people who shall be late, and delay others as well.	وَأَنَّ مِنْكُمْ لَمَنْ لَيَبْطِئَنَّ
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“الْبَطَرُ” (*al-batar*) is that pride and obnoxiousness that is born in a novae riche.
 “يَبْطُرُ” (*yabtur*) basically means to tear up, to split.
 “الْبَيْطَارُ” (*al-baitar*) is a veterinary doctor who performs surgery on animals or tears them apart.

Since excess of wealth makes a shallow person arrogant, therefore this psychological state is also called “بَطَرٌ” (*atar*).

“اِبْطَرَهُ الْمَالُ” (*abtarah almaal*): wealth created obnoxiousness in him {T}.

The Quran says:

8:47	Those who came out of their houses strutting and flaunting	الَّذِينَ خَرَجُوا مِنْ دِيَارِهِمْ بَطَرًا
28:58	Which exulted in its means of livelihood	بَطَرَتْ مَعِيشَتَهَا

“بَطَشَ” (*batash*) or “يَبْطِشُ” (*yabtish*): to take something forcibly.
 “اَلْبَطْشُ” (*al-batsho*): strong grip, or war.
 “بَطَشَ عَلَيْهِ” (*batasha alaihi*): he attacked him quickly.

The Quran says:

7:195	Can they grip anyone with their hands?	أَمْ هُمْ آيِدٍ يَنْبَاطُشُونَ بِهَا
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Surah *Yousuf* says:

85:12	Sustainer's grip (the grip of consequential law or the scheme of things) is very strong.	إِنَّ بَطْشَ رَبِّكَ لَشَدِيدٌ
44:16	the day when We will catch (you) in the strongest of grips	يَوْمَ نَبْطِشُ الْبَطْشَةَ الْكُبْرَى

This means when the time for an outcome is here. This is the grip of the law of justice. On the other hand, it is the grip of oppression which is said to be the hallmark of the annihilated nations.

26:130	when you catch somebody you do it in an oppressive way	وَأَذِ بَطْشَتُمْ بَطْشَتُمْ جَبَّارِينَ
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The system of your Sustainer comes to liberate weak nations from this grip which in turn grabs the oppressors.

“بَاطِلٌ” (*baatil*) is described as an effort which fails to produce any result. This does not mean that there are efforts in this world which are result-less. As per the consequential law created by God, every deed has a result. “بَاطِلٌ” (*baatil*) produces results which are not intended to be to start with.

The Quran has used “بَاطِلٌ” (*baatil*) against “حَقٌّ” (*haqq*), or truth, as in 2:42. As such, to comprehend the right meaning of “بَاطِلٌ” (*baatil*), see the chapter under the heading (*H-Q-Q*) where it has been dealt in detail. In other words, anything or any concept which is not “حَقٌّ” (*haqq*), is “بَاطِلٌ” (*baatil*). For instance “حَقٌّ” (*haqq*): solid, constructive results, as such the meaning of “بَاطِلٌ” (*baatil*) would be destructive efforts or efforts which have a negative or no result, i.e. “بَاطِلٌ” (*baatil*) is not only destructive efforts but any effort which has no result at all. Therefore, “بَطَلَ الشَّيْءَ” (*batalash shaiyi*): for something to go waste {T}.

Ibn Faris says that “بَاطِلٌ” (*baatil*): to keep reducing or to stay for a short while.

Tajul Uroos says that when something is tested according to some criterion and it doesn't come up to the mark, it is "باطل" (*baatil*). In other words, "حق" (*haqq*) is something which meets a criterion while "باطل" (*baatil*) is something which doesn't.

"إبطال" (*ibtaal*): to spoil or waste something even if it is "حق" (*haqq*).
 "بطل الأجير" (*batalal ajeer*): the worker became jobless {T}.

Muheet says that "باطل" (*baatil*) are things in which benefits or characteristics for which they were initially made for, do not fully remain and only their form (or appearance) remains. (This is why he says that it will not be surprising if it means empty or vacant).

With this meaning in mind, all those acts of religion can be branded "باطل" (*baatil*) which are performed formally and the benefits, for which they were suggested, are not being reaped. See the heading (H-K-M), wherein God Himself has pointed out those benefits that we may acquire by following the laws detailed in the Quran. That is why the Quran also use "باطل" (*baatil*) against "نعمّة" (*ne'mata*) that stands for pleasant benefits, as in 16:72, and 29:67.

Because by acting on the principles of "حق" (*haqq*), one will surely reap the "نعمّة" (*ne'mata*) or the good things or benefits. If you are lacking these benefits, then surely your actions are not reflecting "حق" (*haqq*), but rather "باطل" (*baatil*). It does not make any difference if you had mistaken "باطل" (*baatil*) as "حق" (*haqq*). The outcome of your actions testifies if you were on the right track or wrong.

"حق" (*haqq*): something which is resolute in its place. That is why "باطل" (*baatil*) is something which doesn't have permanence {T}. That may appear so, but when investigated, it is not found to have permanence {T}.

The Quran says:

17:81	"haqq" has come and "baatil" is perished. Indeed the "baatil" is destined to be perished.	جاء الحقُّ وَرَهَقَ الْبَاطِلُ إِنَّ الْبَاطِلَ كَانَ زَهُوقًا
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The very word "باطل" (*baatil*) means something which is not going to last. "باطل" (*baatil*) is there till "حق" (*haqq*) arrives. When the light comes, darkness perishes. As such, to destroy "باطل" (*baatil*) one needs to replace it simply with a solid and result producing program.

Constructive efforts must be made and hence peoples positive results shall, by themselves, destroy unconstructive and futile efforts.

11:114	egalitarianism and pleasantness destroy non-egalitarianism and unpleasantness	إِنَّ الْحَسَنَاتِ يُذْهِبْنَ السَّيِّئَاتِ
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When smoothness is applied over an uneven surface, the unevenness gets removed by itself. Thus, it needs to be understood what all the different meanings of "حق" (*haqq*) against the meaning of "باطل" (*baatil*).

"باطل" (*baatil*) also means futile effort, and that which produces weakness in man. This is the result of "باطل" (*baatil*) which can be rectified only by adhering to truth.
 "بطل" (*battalun*), "بطل" (*batal*) is a very brave man who doesn't value any one's blood (life), and is ready to destroy it needlessly {T}.

“بَطْنٌ” (*batan*): stomach, or the inside of something. Its plural is “بُطُونٌ” (*botoon*).
 “الْبَطْنُ” (*al-baton*) is the opposite of “ظَهْرٌ” (*zahrūn*) {*T*}.

Muheet says that the actual meaning of this root is to be empty (vacant) and to be absolved.

Raghib says the slide of everything is “بَطْنٌ” (*batan*) and rise is “ظَهْرٌ” (*zahrūn*).

“الْبَطْنُ” (*al-batnu*) is the stomach, the internal part of anything.

“بَطْنُ الْأَمْرِ” (*batan-ul-amr*) is the internal situation of any matter {*T, R*}.

“الْبِطَانَةُ مِنَ الثَّوَابِ” (*al-bitanatu minas saub*) is the inside lining of clothes as in 55:52. From this, it came to mean confidante, i.e. someone who can go inside and acquire knowledge about internal matters {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

3:117	except (from) your own group, don't allow anyone the position where he may investigate your internal secrets	لَا تَتَّخِذُوا بِطَانَةً مِّن دُونِكُمْ
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Zajaaj says “الْبِطَانَةُ” (*al-bitana*) are people with authority with whom one can have talks openly and they can be included in on the secrets. Hence it also means secret.

The Quran define God as:

57:3	He is the first and the last, the obvious and the hidden	هُوَ الْأَوَّلُ وَالْآخِرُ وَالظَّاهِرُ وَالْبَاطِنُ
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For the full meaning, see heading (*Ze-He-R*).

When one deliberates upon God's creations in the universe, he can have an idea about the Creator of the universe. In other words, the creations lead him to the opinion that all this must have a Creator, and at the back of this mind-boggling machinery, there is some great and tactful power at work. In this manner God is obvious or “الظَّاهِرُ” (*az-zahiro*). But He is not visible to the eye for that matter.

3:104	He cannot be comprehended through sight. (He can't be seen)	لَا تُدْرِكُهُ الْأَبْصَارُ
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This way, He is also “الْبَاطِنُ” (*al-baatino*) or hidden. Hence some people interoperate it to mean that, all which is visible in the universe, is God, and all which is not visible, is the hidden part of God. In other words, all that is hidden behind these manifestations is God Himself. This is a misconception and totally against the teachings of the Quran, and it is akin to the Hindu concept of *Vedant*.

The Quran says:

6:120	And keep away from the obvious and hidden sin	وَذَرُوا ظَاهِرَ الْإِثْمِ وَبَاطِنَهُ
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This means the physical sins as well as the nonphysical sins. They include the sins committed by the eyes to observe, as well as those sinful thoughts which cross our minds.

“بَعَثَ” (*ba’as*): to remove any obstacle in the free movement of something or somebody and thus make the movement possible.
 “بَعَثَ النَّاقَةَ” (*ba’asan naqah*): he let the camel loose to go free.

Surah *At-Tatfeef* says:

83:4 83:5	Do they think that they shall be able to go freely on this grand duration?	أَلَا يَظُنُّ أُولَئِكَ أَنَّهُمْ مَبْعُوثُونَ لِيَوْمٍ عَظِيمٍ
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In this surah the Quran has brought forth a very basic and important principle of economics. It says that in capitalism, “businessman mentality” is such that a capitalist while receiving from others takes the full due, but when he gives (to the labourer) then gives him less than he (the labourer) produces. The truth is that the whole capitalist system is dependent on this type of mentality, but Allah’s law does not allow this. It doesn’t allow giving anyone less than what he produces. This brings a change in the entire society.

At present, the situation is such that the capitalists think that the system which they have created cannot be changed by anyone. The Quran says that they are wrong. This system will vanish, and these people (the capitalists) have been let lose “أَنَّهُمْ مَبْعُوثُونَ” (*annahum maboosoon*) till such time of the great revolution “لِيَوْمٍ عَظِيمٍ” (*lee yaumey azeem*), when mankind, pestered by this wrong system, will rise for establishing God’s universal sustenance.

83:6	The duration during which mankind shall face the sustenance of the world.	يَوْمَ يَقُومُ النَّاسُ لِرَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ
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The capitalist system which, like a leash less camel, is growing as it wants will ultimately result in mankind rising to establish God’s system of universal sustenance, in which taking or giving will be on equal basis.

“أَلْبَعَثَ” (*al-ba’aso*): to send/post/appoint somebody’.

10:75	then We sent <i>Moosa</i> after him	ثُمَّ بَعَثْنَا مِنْ بَعْدِهِم مُّوسَى
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It also means to make someone get up from where he is sitting, or to wake someone up from sleep {*T, M*} as in 6:60.

“أَلْبَعَثَ” (*al-bayeso*): someone who keep waking up at night.

“أَلْبَعَثَ فَلَانَ لِشَانِهِ” (*inn ba’asa falanoon li-shanehi*) is said or spoken when someone rises up in anger and goes to do his work.

“أَلْبَعَثَ” (*ba’ass*): cause or motive, because it removes the hurdle in acting and gets man to get up and go.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:56	then we raised you from your stupor	ثُمَّ بَعَثْنَاكُمْ مِنْ بَعْدِ مَوْتِكُمْ
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The above verse means that all hurdles that were preventing you from being sensible were removed by us and you were awakened once again. The same surah goes on to say:

2:259	then Allah kept him dead for a hundred years and then raised him again	فَأَمَّا تِلْكَ الْأَمْةُ مَاءَ عَامٍ ثُمَّ بَعَثَهُ
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This is a detailed allegory to the life and death of a nation. Here “بَعَثَ” (*ba’as*): to remove those hurdles preventing a resurrection of the nation. After the destruction of the *Baitul-Muqaddas*, i.e. the temple of Solomon, the *Bani-Israel* were in a bad state. Details can be found in my book *Barq-e-Toor*.

This root has been used in the meaning of sending messengers in 2:129, and to appoint someone for a given task in 4:35,

4:35	appoint someone from his/her family as the arbitrator	هَيْمًا يُعْثَرُوا حَكَمًا مِّنْ أَهْلِهِ
7:5	gave them domination over you	يُعْثَرْنَا عَلَيْكُمْ

“يَوْمَ الْبَعْثِ” (*yaumul ba'sey*) or “يَوْمَ يُبْعَثُونَ” (*yaumey yubasoon*) are important phrases like “يَوْمَ الدِّينِ” (*yaum-id-din*) in the Quran. The meaning of which can only be determined with reference to context, basically they mean life anew or the time for the appearance of the results. Life anew can happen after the collective death of a nation, or a second life after death (in the form of Life Hereafter).

B-Ain-Th-R ب ع ث ر

“بَعَثَهُ” (*ba'sara*): sought him and looked for him.
 “بَعَثَ الشَّيْءَ” (*ba'sarah shaiyi*): he took the thing out and opened it.
 “بَعَثَ الْحَوْضَ” (*ba'saral hauz*): he demolished the (small) pool and brought the lower portion upwards.
 “بَعَثَ مَتَاعَهُ” (*ba'sara mata-oo*): he ransacked his belongings.
 “الْبَعْثَرَةُ” (*al-ba'sara*): nausea {*T, M*}. This too has the connotation of something being upside down.

The Quran says:

82:4	when the quboor will be turned upside down	وَإِذَا الْقُبُورُ بُعْثِرَتْ
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This means that after search and investigation the things that are buried will be taken out.
 For “قُبُورٌ” (*quboor*) see heading (*Q-B-R*).

100:9	Whatever there is in the <i>quboor</i> will all be taken out.	إِذَا بُعْثِرَ مَا فِي الْقُبُورِ
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B-Ain-D ب ع د

“بُعْدٌ” (*boa'd*): distance, to be distanced. It is the opposite of “قُرْبٌ” (*qurbun*) that means close, as used in 21:109.
 “بُعِدَ” (*ba'id*), “يُبْعَدُ” (*yab'id*), “بُعْدًا” (*ba-ada*), “بُعْدٌ” (*boa'dan*) to be killed, to be destroyed {*T, M*}. It means to be removed from the pleasantries of life.

Quran says:

11:44	There is destruction for the oppressing nation (They will be removed from life's happiness)	بُعْدًا لِّلْقَوْمِ الظَّالِمِينَ
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“بُعِدُوا وَبَاعِدُوا” (*ba'yeedun wa ba'eedun wa bu'aad*): which is to be distance (removed), which will be destroyed {*T, M*}.
 “بُعْدٌ” (*ba'd*) is the opposite of past, or the times to come after a period that has passed {*T, M*}.
 “الْبُعْدُ” (*al-abad'o*) is the opposite of “الْقُرْبُ” (*al-aqrab*) or that which is near. It also means a renegade, and hence “الْبُعْدَاءُ” (*al-bu'ada*) is used for foreigners. It also means “غَيْرٌ” (*ghair*), which means something strange, not familiar.

45:23	Who else (except Allah) can show him the way (the right guidance can only be given by Allah)	فَمَنْ يَهْدِيهِ مِن بَعْدِ اللَّهِ
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It also means “despite”:

2:178	The one who rebels despite this, for him there is painful punishment.	فَمَنْ اعْتَدَىٰ بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ فَعَلَهُ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ
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“الْبَعِيرُ” (*al-baeer*): camel, a young camel.

“الْبَعِيرُ” (*al-baeer*) also means donkey. It is said for an animal which is used for loading.

“الْبَعْرُ” (*al-ba'ro*) is the droppings of a goat {T}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:72	a camels (or donkeys) load	حَمَلُ بَعِيرٍ
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“بَعْضٌ” (*ba'z*) is a part of something, whether big or small, as in 2:85. For example, eight is the “بَعْضُ” (*ba'az*) of ten and so is two.

“بَعْضَ الشَّيْءِ” (*ba'dus shai-aa*): the thing was divided up.

“تَبَعِيزٌ” (*taba eezun*): to separate, or divide {T}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:72	when some of them meet their own in private, (or go to them)	إِذَا خَلَا بِبَعْضِهِمْ إِلَى بَعْضٍ
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“بَعْضُنَا” (*ba'zo-na*) is someone among us. Some dictionary scholars think that “بَعْضٌ” (*ba'zo*) also means total or whole and quote this following verse as proof:

40:28	all that you are warned of will visit upon you	يُصِيبُكُمْ بَعْضُ الَّذِي يَعِدُكُمْ
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But, in this verse, the meaning of “all” may also be taken as “some”. Also see 43:63.

“بَعُوضَةٌ” (*ba'uza*), the plural of which is “بَعُوضٌ” (*ba'ooz*): mosquito as in 2:26, since it is very small in comparison to other creatures {M}.

“بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*) is high land which cannot be reached (inundated) by flood water. It also means every tree, plant or crop that sucks water for irrigation with its own roots. From the connotation of loftiness and not being dependent on anyone, this word has come to mean owner or lord.

Ibn Faris writes that it basically means *sahib* which also includes the meanings of friend and companion in addition to “lord”. It also means “surprise” and “bewilderment”, as well as “loftiness”.

Raghib says the Arabs used to call their idols “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*) because they thought that they were high and mighty. Their society had the concept that man is dominant over women, which is why husbands too were called “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*). Its plural is “بُعُولَةٌ” (*ba'ula*). Everything which overwhelmed or dominated others was also called “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*). But they also knew that all dominant figures become a burden after sometime, and so a load or burden was also called “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*). As such “أَصْبَحَ فُلَانٌ بَعْلًا عَلَى أَهْلِهِ” (*asbaha falanun ba'ala ala ahlihi*): a person who has become a burden for his folks {T}.

Since the Arabs called the husband “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*), the Quran also uses this word in this meaning in 2:228, 24:31. So here the word does not mean dominance but husband.

William Lane has written (with several references) that “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*) is used for both husband and wife in the same manner as “زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*). Just as “زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*) can have “زَوْجَةٌ” (*zauja*), which is the specific female form, “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*) can have “بَعْلَةٌ” (*ba'lah*). Therefore, there is no connotation of dominance in this word, but only of husband and wife.

As the Quran has declared “نِكَاح” (*nikah*) which is marriage according to the Islamic way, as a sacred pact, there is no question of dominance of one over the other.

The writer of *Muheet* says that the difference between “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*) and “زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*) is that latter means every husband, but he becomes “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*) after he has consummated the marriage.

Ilyas’ (Elijah’s) nation used to call its idol “بَعْلٌ” (*ba'al*) as it appears in 37:125. It was the most favorite of all among the Semitic tribes. It used to be worshipped in Syria. The *Torah* also mentions it (33:2 - 33:3).

B-Gh-T

ب غ ت

“الْبَغْتُ” (*al-baghto*) and “الْبَغْتَةُ” (*al-baghta*): suddenly.
 “الْمُبَاغَاتَةُ” (*al-mubaghata*): to reach one another suddenly {T}.

Raghib says it means for something to appear from an unexpected place.

The Quran says:

6:31	when the moment (السَّاعَةُ) sneaks up upon them suddenly	إِذَا جَاءَ تُهُمُ السَّاعَةُ بَغْتَةً
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(To understand the concept of “السَّاعَةُ” (*assa'ah*) see heading (S-Ain-W).

The same surah says further ahead:

6:47	God’s punishment can come suddenly, or there may come signs first and then the punishment itself	إِنْ أَتَاكُمْ عَذَابُ اللَّهِ بَغْتَةً أَوْ جَهْرَةً
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It is hence clear that “بَغْتَةً” (*bagh-tatan*) means a situation in which some event happens revolutionarily or as an emergent evolution, not evolutionary. It must be understood that the result of an action starts to register right at the beginning of the action but it takes time to fully manifest itself.

Surah *Al-Anbia* says:

21:12	when they felt our punishment	فَلَمَّا أَحَسُّوا بَأْسَنَا
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In other words, the punishment was being prepared and could be felt only afterwards. In some cases signs of the impending punishment start appearing before its actual advent, this is called “جَهْرَةً” (*jahra*). Sometimes the punishment is sudden, and is called “بَغْتَةً” (*bagh-ta*).

39:25	They were visited by the punishment from a place they had no knowledge about. (Which could not be comprehended by them earlier.)	فَأَنذَرْتَهُمُ الْعَذَابَ مِنْ حَيْثُ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ
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The nations which view only the superficial indicators try to assess the causes of a disaster from the physical causes that were present at the time of the punishment or disaster; in fact, however, the causes go back.

“الْبُغْضُ” (*al-bughz*): this word is opposite of “الْحُبُّ” (*al-hoobb*) – ‘love’; to be unloved or disgusted with something. “الْبُغْضَاءُ” (*al-baghzaa*) is ‘the height of disgust’ as used in 3:117 {T, R, M}.

“الْبَغْلُ” (*al-baghl*): an ass {T}. The plural is “بِغَالٌ” (*bi-ghaal*) as in 16:8.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is of physical strength.

The ass is called “الْبَغْلُ” (*al-baghl*) because of its physical strength.

“الْتَبْغِيلُ” (*at-tabgheel*) is used for a body that is big and strong {T}. Since an ass is born of a mare and a donkey, therefore “بَغْلٌ” (*baghl*) is used for any crossbred animal.

Since a mule comes into being through the mating of a mare and a donkey, therefore this animal is also called “بَغْلٌ” (*baghl*) because is born out of the coupling of two different genres.

“الْبَغْيُ” (*al-baghyi*) is the wish to overstep the middle path (regardless of whether one can actually do or not).

“الْبَغْيُ” (*al-baghyo*): too much rain that exceeds all measures.

“بَغَتِ السَّمَاءُ” (*baghatil samai*) is the cloud that exceeds its limit, meaning that it rained a lot. These are the basic meanings of this word.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to ask for something and to be spoilt.

“فِءَةٌ بِأَغْيَةٍ” (*fe'ateh baghia*) is a party or group that opposes the order and rebel.

“الْبَغْيَا” (*al-baghya*) are those soldiers who move ahead for making prior arrangements.

“بَغِيَ يَبْغِي” (*bagha yabgha*): he became too proud and exceeded his limits.

“تَبَاغَوْا” (*tabaghau*): to commit excesses on one another.

“بَغَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ بَغَاءً” (*baghatil mar'ato begha'a*): the woman exceeded the limits of decency.

“بَغْيٌ” (*baghyun*) and “بَغْوٌ” (*baghu'a*) is a fornicating woman.

“بَغَى عَلَيْهِ” (*bagha alaih*) is to commit excess against or on someone, to oppress someone, to be high handed against somebody, and be jealous of someone. If the envy is for a good thing then the envy also becomes good otherwise not {T}.

“إِبْتِغَاءٌ” (*ibtigha*): to struggle in pursuit of something. If the search is for something good, then the search becomes limited, otherwise a wild chase {T}.

“الْبَغْيَةُ” (*al-bighyah*) and “الْبَغْيَةُ” (*al-bughiya*) is the thing which is being looked for, which one intends to possess. It also means something which is lost and for which a great search is mounted.

“الْبَاغِي” (*al-ba'ghi*) also means one who searches {T}.

“إِنْبَغَى الشَّيْءُ” (*in bagh-ash shaiyi*) is for something to become easy, to be acquired, or to be befitting.

“مَا يَنْبَغِي” (*ma yanbaghi*): this is not correct or proper, or this is not possible, or this is not permitted {T}.

Muheet says it signifies leaning towards one of two things and the justification for the other.

Surah *Yaseen* says:

36:69	We did not teach the Messenger poetry	وَمَا عَلَّمْنَاهُ الشُّعْرَ وَمَا يَنْبَغِي لَهُ
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Nor can the psychological makeup of a revolutionary preacher be such that emotions rule over the truths (and this is what a poet's psychology is based upon).

36:69	what he has been given are the facts of history and clear cut laws for life	إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ وَقُرْآنٌ مُبِينٌ
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How can then there be room for emotional leanings? For details see heading (Sh-Ain-R).

The Quran says:

22:60	the oppressed	بُغِيَ عَلَيْهِ
4:104	Don't be slack in pursuing the enemy (try your best to pursue him)	وَلَا تَهِنُوا فِي ابْتِغَاءِ
3:6	The intention to create fitna (mayhem)	ابْتِغَاءِ الْفِتْنَةِ

About **Qaroon** it is said:

28:70	he used to commit excesses on them. (wanted to stay ahead of them) (<i>Gharibul Quran by Mirza Abul Fazal</i>)	فَبَغَى عَلَيْهِمْ
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It also means to demand power and kingdom.

Surah **An-Noor** uses the word “الْبَغَاءُ” (*al-ibghao*) for fornication in 24:33, but in surah **Maryam** it is used for transgressing. In Surah Mariam this word has been used for committing crime in 19:20, and not specifically for fornication. That is, Maryam said “I am living like a nun, and the law is that a nun should live a life of celibacy, I have hence not broken that law.” It is to be remembered there were allegations against Maryam that she had adopted an ordinary life (and not a celibate life as was required of her) and this was against the law. That is why they said to her that her mother was not one to break laws (19:28). Then, could she break the law?

Isa (Jesus) in reply had said “your laws are self-made. I have been made a messenger by God, and given the book (The Bible). This book contains no such law (i.e. of celibacy). That is why my mother has not done anything against Gods law.

But if “بَغِيًّا” (*baghiyyan*) is taken to mean “evil-doer” then this verse would mean that Maryam said that “I am living a life of celibacy (under the Temple) therefore there is no question of my mating with anyone”. Another meaning can be of “wrong-doing”. Then this verse would mean “but I am not corrupt either, so how can I give birth to a child?” This is during the time when Maryam was living a celibate life as a nun under the Temple rules. Later when she came to know of the teachings of Allah, she left the life of a nun and started living a normal life with the child. Since it was un-thinkable, i.e. leaving sisterhood and living a family life, therefore, they considered Maryam’s life as a life of corruption. **Isa** had refuted their self made laws and defended his mother even as a child.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says that the Jews oppose the Quran because they are jealous as to why the Quran, instead of being revealed to the dynasty of **Bani Israel**, was revealed to one from **Bani Ismail** (i.e. **Muhammed**). For this (jealousy) “بَغِيًّا” (*baghiyan*) has been used in 2:90.

The Quran, after discussing “**haram** and **halal**” (permissible and non-permissible) in edibles says:

2:173	due to hunger if someone faces death then he has done no crime	فَمَنْ اضْطُرَّ غَيْرَ بَاغٍ وَلَا عَادٍ فَلَا إِثْمَ عَلَيْهِ
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This means that he is absolved and is permitted to eat the forbidden things, provided that he takes only as much as necessary to save his life and doesn't exceed the limit, and also if his intention is not to break the law. In other words, neither should he take just because he wants to nor should he take more than necessary (just enough to save his life).

Note that although “بَغِيًّا” (*baghiy*) is masculine in gender, it is also used in feminine terms.

“بَقَرٌ” (*baqar*): to tear up/ apart something like cutting up some animal’s stomach.
 “بَقَرُ الْعِلْمِ” (*baqaral-ilm*): deep research and inquiry.
 “بَاقِرٌ” (*baqir*): a lion and also a scholar {*T, M*}.

Baqar can either mean a cow or a bull {*T*}. It is the plural while the singular is “بَقَرَةٌ” (*baqarah*). This word appears in the tale of **Bani Israel** in 2:67. Whatever that is written in the verses that follow shows that this word was meant for the bulls which were not meant for work but were let to roam free, in the name of the their gods. They used to worship the bull in Egypt and this emotion had embedded itself, consciously or subconsciously in the minds of **Bani Israel**. In order to eradicate this emotion, the order for slaughtering cows was given.

“الْبَاقِعُ” (*al-baqey*) is a spotted crow or a dog.

Ibn Faris says it basically means the difference in colors.

“الْبَاقِعَةُ” (*al-bage’a*) is a bird which is very alert and looking around finds out whether it is being hunted. In order to drink, unlike other birds, it goes to some unfamiliar spot {*T, M*}.

According to the earlier stated meaning, “أَرْضٌ بَقَعَةٌ” (*arzun baq-eta*) is a land with greenery at some places while other spots are barren (spotted land).

“الْبُقْعَةُ” (*al-buga’t*) is the land which is not similar to the surrounding land {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

28:30	in the mubarak (established and developing) land with the trees (which is different than its surroundings)	فِي الْبُقْعَةِ الْمُبَارَكَةِ مِنَ الشَّجَرَةِ
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“الْبُقْعَةُ” (*al-baq’ato*) is also a place where water has accumulated.

“بَقَلَ الشَّيْءُ” (*baqalash-shaiyi*): the thing appeared.
 “بَقَلَتِ الْأَرْضُ” (*baqalatil ard*): vegetables appeared on the land.

Raghib says that “بَقْلٌ” (*baqlun*) are vegetables which lose their branches and roots in winter.
Ibn Faris says that this word basically means “fertility”.

Abu Ziad says whatever first appears (grows) on land is “بَقْلٌ” (*baql*).

According to **Aqrabul Muwarid**, “بَقْلٌ” (*baql*): such vegetables which do not grow under the soil (like potato, carrot, turnip etc.) but above the soil like cauliflower, tomato, etc.

The Quran uses this word to mean “vegetables” in 2:61.

“بَقِيَ” (*baqiyyu*), “يَبْقَى” (*yabqa*), “بَقَاءٌ” (*baqa’a*) is used for something to remain in its state and not undergo change. It is the opposite of “فَنَاءٌ” (*fanah*) which means to undergo change.
 “إِبْقَاءٌ” (*ibaqa*), “إِسْتِبْقَاءٌ” (*istibqa*) is to remain unchanged {*T, M*}. It also means to protect and guard.

Everything in the universe is undergoing change, but God’s personae are above changes, and so are His laws. These are permanent values. The acts which are according to his laws also beget unchangeable results. By following these laws, the human personality also becomes stable and above change. The basic characteristic of personality is that it remains unchanged in a changing world. For details see my book “*Nizam Raboobiyyat*” and also “*Mun O Yazdan*” and the 5th Volume of “*Ma’aruf-ul- Quran*” with the title “*What Man Thought*”.

See this word in the light of these meanings and how the noble Quran has used words from this root, and its use shall become absolutely clear.

18:46	wealth, progeny, are things for the worldly life (physical life) of Man	الْمَالُ وَالْبَنُونَ زِينَةُ الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا
18:46	According to God’s Law the best acts are those whose enabling results never change. To hope for these is life’s best goal.	وَالْبَاقِيَاتُ الصَّالِحَاتُ خَيْرٌ عِنْدَ رَبِّكَ ثَوَابًا وَخَيْرٌ أَمَلًا
16:96	whatever you have, according to your concepts, is gradually lost, but that which accrues to you according to the law of God, (whether they are the pleasantries of life or the growth of human personality) is foreign to change	مَا عِنْدَكُمْ يَنْفَدُ وَمَا عِنْدَ اللَّهِ

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says: These things are not bad and should not be avoided.

Surah *Hood* says:

11:86	wealth and goods which are acquired according to Allah’s law	بَقِيَّةُ اللَّهِ
11:116	Those possessing a remnant	أُولُوا بَقِيَّةٍ

This has been said for those who obey the laws of Allah.

43:28	A lasting word	كَلِمَةً بَاقِيَةً
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The lasting word is the book about the uniqueness of Allah (the basis for all Quranic teachings) which the messengers leave behind for their followers, and which never changes. The advisers of Pharaoh’s court had termed it as “خَيْرٌ وَأَبْقَى” (*khairun wa abqa*) in 20:73, which means “the most unchanging”.

Surah *Ar-Rahman* says:

55:26	Everything in this universe changes. (The universe is changing all the time.)	كُلُّ مَنْ عَلَيْهَا فَانٍ
55:27	But Sustainer’s personae is above all changes, and His laws, and their results too do not change	وَيَبْقَى وَجْهُ رَبِّكَ ذُو الْجَلَالِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ

The meaning of the word “فَنَاءٌ” (*fana*) as understood today to be “perishing”, is not correct. For details, see heading (*F-N-Y*). For other meanings of “وَجْهَ رَبِّ” (*wajhey rabbey*) see heading (*W-J-He*).

“بَقِيَّةُ الشَّيْءِ” (*baqiyyatush shaiyi*) is the remaining part of anything, but of the same kind. That is why a brother cannot be called “بَقِيَّةُ الْأَبِ” (*baqiyyatul ab*) (the remaining part of father) {*M*}.

About *Bani Israel’s* Arc of the Covenant, it is said:

2:248	The remaining part of the progenies of <i>Moosa</i> and <i>Haroon</i> , which they had left behind.	وَبَقِيَّةٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ آلُ مُوسَى وَآلُ هَارُونَ
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“الْبِكْرُ” (*al-bikro*) with plural “أَبْكَارٌ” (*abkaar*) is used for an unmarried woman, a spinster; also a man who has not had sex with any woman (a male virgin); the mother of the first baby or camel; the first child; any first thing. It also means a cow which has not yet become pregnant, a young cow.

Ibn Faris says these are its basic meanings.

2:68	nor old nor in her prime (young)	لَا قَارِضٌ وَلَا بَكْرٌ
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“الْبُكْرَةُ صَبِيحٌ” (*al-bukrah sub-ha*) is the first part of the day, in other words, i.e. morning. The compiler of *Muheet* says that it is the time from dawn to the *chaasht* (a prayer which is performed before noon). See 3:40 and 3:19. Besides this the root of the word means “to pierce” or “cut” {*T*}. Things which have no precedence are also “الْأَبْكَارُ” (*abkaar*) {*Qamoos*} as in 56:35, 56:36.

The Quran uses the word in this meaning, i.e. with the right teachings and with the acts of virtue the women became totally different from the women of pre-Islam age of ignorance, which had no precedence.

“بَكَّ” (*bakkah*), “يَبْكُ” (*yabakkah*), “بَكَ” (*bakka*) is to tear something up, to separate, to resist. “بَكَ عُنُقَهُ” (*bakka anooqahu*): he broke his neck {*T*}.

Mecca is also called “بَكَّة” (*bakkah*):

3:59	The first house for Humanity is that which is in <i>Bakkah</i> , (a house with blessings).	إِنَّ أَوَّلَ بَيْتٍ وُضِعَ لِلنَّاسِ لَلَّذِي بِبَكَّةَ مُبَارَكًا
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There are different opinions about this name of the city. Some think that people come to it in droves and there is a big crowd in the surroundings, which is why it is called “بَكَّة” (*bakkah*). Some think that the oppressors and the rebels had their necks broken here (lost their power), hence the city is named “بَكَّة” (*bakkah*), but *Raghib* thinks that “بَكَّة” (*bakkah*) is a different form of “مَكَّة” (*Mecca*). There are many examples in Arabic of M being substituted for B {*M*}.

For example, *Sabad* and *Samad*, *Laazib* and *Laazim*. These words have the same meaning regardless if there is B or M in them.

“بَكَمٌ” (*bakam*): to be unable to speak, dumb. *Azhari* says that “أَبْكَمٌ” (*abkum*) and “آخَرَسٌ” (*akhrus*) differ in that the last mentioned means someone who cannot speak from birth, while the first word means one who can speak but is not outspoken, and due to this inability to speak properly, cannot make himself understood. But “أَبْكَمٌ” (*abkum*) also means a person who is deaf, dumb and blind {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says that “أَبْكَمٌ” (*abkum*), plural of which is “بُكْمٌ” (*bekum*), is one who abstains from speaking either on his own will or due to his uncouthness, and also one who cannot describe something clearly.

The Quran says:

2:18	Deaf, dumb, blind	صُمٌّ بُكْمٌ عُمًى فَهُمْ
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Here “بُكْمٌ” (*bukum*) only means dumb, because for deaf and blind the words “صُمٌّ” (*summon*) and “عُمًى” (*umyun*) have been used additionally.

In surah *Al-Anfaal*, it is said:

8:22	According to Allah, the worst creatures are those who are deaf and dumb and hence do not comprehend.	إِنَّ شَرَّ الدَّوَابِّ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ الصُّمُّ الْبُكْمُ الَّذِينَ لَا يَعْقِلُونَ
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Here with the words “صُمُّ” (*summun*) and “بُكْمٌ” (*bukmun*) has been made it clear that the words do not mean those who are physically deaf and dumb, but those who do not employ their intellect.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:76	One of them is dumb and does not understand anything.	أَحَدُهُمَا أَبْكَمٌ لَا يَفْقَهُ عَلَى شَيْءٍ
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This means one who doesn't have the ability to do anything, and is a burden on his boss. If he goes on an errand, he doesn't do it right. Compared to him is one who is powerful or with authority, and who orders justice. He treads the right path. These explanations make it clear that the use of “صُمُّ بُكْمٌ” (*summun bukmun*): those who instead of employing their intellect go blindly along their wrong path.

B-K-Y ب ك ي

“بُكَاءٌ” (*bukaa*): to cry tearfully in sorrow. Sometimes only sorrow or to cry is “بُكَاءٌ” (*bukaa*) {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to cry, and for something to lessen.

The Quran uses “ضَحِكَ” (*zahika*) against “بَلَى” (*ba'kaa*) in 9:82. Therefore it means “to lessen sadness”.

Surah *Ad-Dukhan* says:

44:29	neither the sky nor the earth cried at their destruction	فَمَا بَكَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ السَّمَاءُ وَالْأَرْضُ
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This means that nobody felt sorrow on their behalf because their destruction took place according to the scheme of things, so they just faced consequences of their own actions. Ergo, their destruction was just.

19:58	When they were told about the words of their Sustainer, they bowed down with their full leaning	إِذَا تُتْلَىٰ عَلَيْهِمْ آيَاتُ الرَّحْمَنِ خَرُّوا سُجَّدًا وَبُكِيًّا
25:73	Those who when reminded of their Sustainer's signs, accept them, but not as dumb and blind.	وَالَّذِينَ إِذَا ذُكِّرُوا بِآيَاتِ رَبِّهِمْ لَمْ يَخِرُّوا عَلَيْهَا صُمًّا وَعُمْيَانًا

This verse is about those who obey God's law with full knowledge and understanding, and accept them from the bottom of their heart because their acceptance is based upon their intellect.

Bal بَل

“بَلَى” (*bal*): instead, on the contrary. The following examples will make the meanings clear.

When it comes in the middle of a sentence, it denies the first part and asserts the second.

21:26	And they say that God has taken sons (for Himself). On the contrary, they are His respected missionaries.	وَقَالُوا اتَّخَذَ الرَّحْمَنُ وَلَدًا سُبْحَانَهُ بَلَىٰ عِبَادٌ مُّكْرَمُونَ
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The assertion of one thing without the denial of another:

23:62 23:63	We have a book which speaks the truth, and there is no excess on them, on the contrary their hearts are in sixes and seven and uncouthness.	وَلَدَيْنَا كِتَابٌ يَنْطِقُ بِالْحَقِّ وَهُمْ لَا يُظْلَمُونَ بَلَىٰ قُلُوبُهُمْ فِي غَمْرَةٍ مِّنْ هَٰذَا
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This means that the second part of the verse is separate from the first. Also study 87:14-16, and 85:20-21. Here this word is used to mean “and”. Similarly in 21:62-63 too, this word might begin a new sentence. Details can be found under the relevant headings.

B-L-D

ب ل د

“الْبَلَدُ” (*al-balad*): any part of land, or earth which has a boundary, whether inhabited or uninhabited. The plural is “بِلَادٌ” (*bilad*) and “بُلْدَانٌ” (*buldaan*). It has been used to mean “a village” or “a dwelling”.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says: “بَلَدًا بَلَدًا” (*haaza balada*) in 2:126. Here it can mean either dwelling or a plot of land.

In surah *Al-Balad*, “بِلَدِ الْبَلَدِ” (*bihaazal balad*) refers to the city of Mecca (90:102). The city at another place, 95:3, has been called “الْبَلَدِ الْأَمِينِ” (*al-baladil amen*) which means “the City of Peace”.

Ibrahim had prayed for it to be a place of peace for the oppressed of the world (2:126). That it would become the Centre of Allah’s system of universal sustenance and of the *Momineens*, who are the guarantors of peace in the world he wished that it would indeed become a City of Peace. For more details see headings related to *Hajj* and *Ka’aba*.

“بَلَدُ الْفَرَسِ” (*balladal faras*): the horse lagged behind in the race, or couldn’t surge ahead {*M*}.

“بَلِيدٌ” (*baleed*): an idiot or moron (who stays behind) {*M*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is “chest”

“بَلَدَ الرَّجُلِ بِالْأَرْضِ” (*baladar rojolo bil ard*): the man put his chest against the earth, i.e. he hugged the ground.

B-L-S

ب ل س

Ibn Faris has said that the basic meaning of “أَبْلَسَ” (*ablas*) is of becoming disappointed and hopeless.

21:77	they will lose hope without cause	إِذَا هُمْ فِيهِ مُبْلِسُونَ
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It also means to be surprised or shocked. In ancient Semitic lexicon it meant “to kill by trampling, or trample” {*Ghareeb-ul-Quran*}.

Some believe that “أَبْلِسَ” (*Iblees*) has been derived from “أَبْلَسَ” (*ablas*) which means “permanently without hope about God’s benevolence”, but some other dictionary scholars say that it is not an Arabic word and has been Arabised {*T*}.

The Quran has presented *Iblees* as the embodiment of rebelliousness and mutiny:

2:34	He refused to obey orders, was rebellious and mutinous, became among the disobeyers.	أَبَىٰ وَاسْتَكْبَرَ وَكَانَ مِنَ الْكَافِرِينَ
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This word has come against *malaika* who are obedient by nature:

38:73	All the <i>malaika</i> bowed to him	فَسَجَدَ الْمَلَائِكَةُ كُلُّهُمْ أَجْمَعُونَ
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Man is the only creature in the entire universe who has been given the freedom of choice, when it comes to obeying the laws of God or disobey them if he so chooses. No other creation has been given the right to disobey (go against God’s laws). Man disobeys God when his emotions get the better of him. These emotions rouse him towards personal benefit as against the universal good, and thus he lays God’s laws aside and follows such emotions. Hence his intellect tells him how to achieve those ends. The Quran has

called such emotions and such intellect, which leads him on to this end “أَبْلِيسَ” (*Iblees*), and due to its rebelliousness said that it has been created out of fire (*naar*) 7:12.

And since these emotions are hidden from the naked eye, and work in the subconscious, they are called “كَانَ مِنَ الْجِنِّ” (*kaana minal djinn*) in 18:50 (*djinn* means hidden). Since these emotions (due to which Man can disobey God’s laws) are born with him and stay with him as long as he lives, the Quran says that “أَبْلِيسَ” (*Iblees*) and Man co-exist (see heading *Adam*). “أَبْلِيسَ” (*Iblees*) has been given time along with Man till the very last moment.

15:36	He said “My Sustainer, give me time till they are reawaken”	رَبِّ فَأَنْظِرْنِي إِلَى يَوْمِ يُبْعَثُونَ
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But if you look at the depth of the meaning of the word “بَعَثَ” (*ba’as*), then the meaning of “يَوْمِ يُبْعَثُونَ” (*yوم ba’asoon*) becomes something else. “بَعَثَ” (*ba’as*) means “to remove obstacles from the way of someone’s freedom”, hence “to grant freedom”. So what *Iblees* was told is that his activity was to break loose the moral codes of the people. Hence as long as people do not break their moral codes and get towards a common freedom, its presence shall be required. When they shall be able to do so by themselves, then the services of *Iblees* shall no longer be required. *Iblees* needs this due, and hence it is granted. It is a fact that it takes some effort to break loose from moral principles at first. But when it finally happens, it comes very natural for man to simply go with the flow.

The person who mutinies against God’s laws is deprived of all the happiness which would have accrued to him by following His laws. Therefore “أَبْلِيسَ” (*Iblees*) has been termed deprived and hopeless.

Those who live according to the laws of Allah:

2:38	they will have no fear nor sorrow	فَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ
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About them it is also said that they will not be overwhelmed by *Iblees* in any way (15:42). The Quran has described “أَبْلِيسَ” (*Iblees*) and “شَيْطَانُ” (*Shaitan*) as two sides of the same coin when, for example, it refers to the tale of Adam. In this tale *Iblees* refuses to bow before Adam, commits mutiny, shows pride and challenges God to mislead the mankind. These are all actions of *Iblees*. But where *Adam*’s fault is mentioned, it has been linked to *Shaitaan* (the opposer).

2:36	Then the <i>Shaitan</i> made them (both) slip	فَأَزَلَّهُمَا الشَّيْطَانُ
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Also see 7:11-20 and 20:116-120.

This makes it obvious that *Shaitan* is actually a particular sort of mentality (not a person or being) and the way it works or operates is called *shaitan*. For details on *Shaitan* see heading (*Sh-Te-N*). For details of all these terms, see my book "*Iblees O Adam*" which is one in my series to an introduction to the Quran i.e. *Muarif-ul-Quran*.

Iblees and *Shaitan* are those obstacles which hamper human intellect in its natural growth. If the human intellect overcomes these hurdles and thus proves itself to be solid and steadfast, the evolutionary system moves ahead, but if these hurdles prove insurmountable, then that intellect is confined to the lower (or animal) level of life. Life, in fact, is the name of this very struggle between Man and *Iblees*, and that is why the existence of *Iblees* along with Man is inevitable. The human personality cannot find stability without opposition and clashes, or in other words, its solidarity cannot be tested without these. For the continuous flow of water, a waterfall is most essential. What remains to be seen is whether the water becomes a stagnant pool due to this (fall) obstacle or keeps its flow despite the hurdle. To select such a path, in which the hurdles of sect, celibacy, etc. are not present, is to stultify your own flow. So, life is a continuous struggle between Man and *Iblees*.

And it is said that *Iblees* (hopelessness) and *Shaitan* (rebelliousness) are two sides of the same coin. Modern psychology supports the theory that hopelessness leads to rebelliousness or aggressiveness. When Man finds something not being according to his wishes, he gets frustrated. If he takes out the frustration

on himself, the result is worry or gloominess which might end in self-destruction. When the frustration is against the cause of frustration, it appears as vengeance, but if that is not plausible, then he takes out his anger or frustration against things which are not even related to the cause. This is the beginning of madness, thus this shows how closely hopelessness and rebelliousness, and in other words *Iblees* and *Shaitaan*, are related.

These are the psychological frames of the human mind. The Quranic laws create a society which has no room for hopelessness for its members.

39:53	don't lose hope in Allah's benevolence	لَا تَقْنَطُوا مِنْ رَحْمَةِ اللَّهِ
7:156	and this benevolence encompasses everything necessary for the growth of life	وَرَحْمَتِي وَسِعَتْ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ

Thus in such a society hopelessness cannot overwhelm anyone. This is why the Quran says:

15:42	Surely you cannot overwhelm My mission takers.	إِنَّ عِبَادِي لَيْسَ لَكَ عَلَيْهِمْ سُلْطَانٌ
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Also see headings (*Q-N-Te*), and (*Y-A-S*).

B-L-Ain ب ل ع

“بَلَعَ” (*bale'a*), “يَبْلَعُ” (*yablah*): to swallow something.
 “الْمَبْلَعُ” (*al-mabla'o*) is the place from where food gets down to the stomach.
 “الْبَلُوعُ” (*al-baloo'o*): something which is meant to be drunk.
 “الْبُلْعَةُ” (*al-bul'a*): a sip {T}.

Besides this, it also means the opening of a grain mill down which the grain is put {M}.

About the storm during Noah's time, God commands the ground to:

11:44	Swallow your water (absorb it)	ابْلَعِي مَائَكَ
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B-L-Gh ب ل غ

“بَلَغَ الْمَكَانَ بُلُوغًا” (*balagh-al-makana bulugha*): that he reached the spot. It is said that “بُلُوغٌ” (*bulugh*) and “بِلَاغٌ” (*balagh*) mean to reach the ultimate end, whether that is with regards to right place or time. It also means something estimated, but sometimes this word is used for just getting close.

As the Quran has said:

2:231	when they are getting close to completion of <i>idda</i> (When they reach the last limit of the appointed time)	فَإِذَا بَلَغْنَ أَجَلَهُنَّ
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The Waiting Period (*'idda*) in 2:231 is not for a widow, but for a divorcee, and it is 3 months/menstruation (given in 2:228). A widow's *'idda* (4 months and 10 days) is given in 2:234.

“الْبَلَاغُ” (*al-balgh*) is for something to be enough or sufficient in order to make a man realise his goal through it, so he may not require any further means for this {T}.
 “الْبُلْغَةُ” (*al-bulgha*) is any such thing with which one can reach some goal {T}.

The Arab tent-dwellers used to roam the desert, since their lives depended on water. There were some wells in the desert, and a rope and a bucket used to be kept on the well wall. However, the water level of the wells was not constant in warm areas. Sometimes the level was so low that the bucket (with its rope) could not reach the water. As a counter measure these Arabs used to keep a rope with them and in such cases tied it to the existing rope “الرِّشَاءُ” (*ar-risha*) of the bucket so that the bucket could reach the water. This piece of extra rope was called “التَّبْلِغَةُ” (*at-tabligha*). This makes the meaning of the word “تبليغ” (*tableegh*) or preaching clear, which means that a man lacks the capacity to reach a meaning himself, then

this shortcoming is overcome somehow by some preacher so that he can grasp the meaning. But if he doesn't want to use his piece of rope "الرَّشَاءُ" (*ar-risha*) then only "التَّبْلِغَةُ" (*tabligha*) cannot alone take him to the water. "تَبْلِيغٌ" (*tableegh*) can only benefit those who use their own intellect and insight. "مَبْلَغٌ" (*mablagh*) is the last destination which somebody may reach (53:30)

God has termed the Quran as "بَلَاغٌ لِلنَّاسِ" (*balaghun naas*) in 14:52. In other words, it is the medium through which man can reach his goal and does not require the presence of any other medium to do so. So the Quran is the medium through which Man can reach his destiny, but it can only take those to their ultimate destination who obey it, those who live according to its dictates.

This is because the Quran says:

21:106	This balgh is only for those who truly accept the mission of God	إِنَّ فِي هَذَا لَبَلَاغًا لِّقَوْمٍ عَابِدِينَ
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It has been left to Man's discretion to take the right path according to the Quran or take some other (the wrong path). Nobody can be forced to choose a particular way of life. If they had meant to be forced, then God would have created Man in a way in which he couldn't disobey Him. All the other creations in the universe are compelled to traverse a certain path only. Therefore the messengers came to deliver Allah's message to the people, not to force them to follow those laws.

16:35	Messengers have no more responsibility than to explain and deliver God's laws to the people.	فَهَلْ عَلَى الرُّسُلِ إِلَّا الْبَلَاغُ الْمُبِينُ
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"بَالِغَةٌ" (*baligha*) in 68:39, means something that reaches its goal.

B-L-W ب ل و

"بَلَاءٌ" (*balaun*), "إِبْتِلَاءٌ" (*ibtela-un*).

Raghib says this word has two meanings:

- To obtain information about one's welfare or to acquire information about him.
- For the real condition of something to become known, whether good or bad.

When the word is used for God, it would have only the second meaning, because God knows it all, and one cannot even imagine that He is unaware of any condition $\{T, R\}$. Therefore, the word's basic meaning is to portray the reality.

"بَلِيٌّ" (*bali*), "يَبْلَى" (*yabla*) is used for a cloth to become old and worn. Because when a cloth has been worn out, its real condition comes to light. Therefore "بَلَاءٌ" (*bala*) is used for a man's real personality to come out during times of difficulties and misery. But it does not necessarily mean that identity of everything has to be bad. It can also be good. That is why it could also mean the real personality of someone during happy times. There are two times when a man's reality becomes manifest, times of misery and times of happiness. At both these times, his real self appears.

"اَلْمُبَالَاةُ" (*al-mubalah*): to boast, or to pride oneself as to the better position in life against another $\{M\}$.
 "إِبْتِلَاءٌ" (*ibtelaa*): to select, to choose $\{T\}$.

In surah *Al-Baqrah*, the **Bani Israel** has been told Pharaoh's nation perpetrated different excesses on you, but We delivered you from their oppression.

2:49	the deliverance from their oppression provided the opportunity to watch how you behave upon getting freedom	وَفِي ذَلِكُمْ بَلَاءٌ مِّن رَّبِّكُمْ عَظِيمٌ
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Surah *Al-Anfaal* says that God granted victory to the Momineen in the battle field of **Badr**:

8:17	so it is through successes in this world that they are given the opportunity to show the world how to behave during good times	لِيُبَيِّنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ مِنْهُ بَلَاءٌ حَسَنًا
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Some dictionaries have combined the roots (**B-L-W**) and (**B-L-Y**). But we have presented them as separate headings, though they have only a very fine difference between them, so fine that at times they are difficult to differentiate.

Surah *Ad-Dukhan* says that the **Bani Israel** are told that they have been given all this “مَا فِيهِمْ بَلَاءٌ مُّبِينٌ” (*ma feehey balawun mubeen*) in 44:33, which had everything needed for their growth. It also means “to make evident”.

The Quran says:

86:9	The day when every hidden thing will be made evident	يَوْمَ تُبْلَى السَّرَائِرُ
3:153	So that Allah may make those things evident which were in your heart	لِيُبَيِّنَ اللَّهُ مَا فِي صُدُورِكُمْ
10:30	There every one's act shall be made evident for him, that he had committed	هُنَالِكَ تَبْلُو كُلُّ نَفْسٍ مَّا أَسْلَفَتْ

In surah *Al-mominoon*, after describing things about the nation of *Nooh*, it is said:

23:30	This is how We make (the tales about former nations) evident	وَإِنْ كُنَّا لَمُبَيِّنِينَ
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The struggle between Right and Wrong goes on. In this struggle we get familiar with different facts of life. Sometimes one is faced with trying aspects and at other times with peaceful aspect of life's happiness. This has been described by the Quran as “اِبْتَلَى” (*ibtela*), meaning the different faces of life which keep appearing. In surah *Al-Fajr*, this meaning is made clear (see 89:15-16). This way man can determine as to see how far his capabilities go, because he can only face the difficult aspects of life to the extent to which his latent qualities have developed. These hurdles that he faces are actually a man's opportunities for development of his own personality. This is what “اِبْتَلَى” (*ibtela*).

Surah *Al-Baghr* says:

2:144	And when his Sustainer provided <i>Ibrahim</i> , opportunities to develop his personality, through various laws...	وَإِذِ ابْتَلَىٰ إِبْرَاهِيمَ رَبُّهُ بِكَلِمَاتٍ
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When, as per the laws of God, life's many events (difficulties) came into his (*Ibrahim's*) life, so that He viewed how far *Ibrahim's* capabilities had developed. The way *Ibrahim* faced these difficulties (the way he reacted) made clear that his capabilities had developed to the utmost. That his capabilities had developed fully.

“فَاتَمَّهَنَّ” (*fatamahunna*) as in 2:124, makes it clear that the concept of “اِبْتَلَى” (*ibtela*) being a “test” from God, as we usually believe, is not what Quran thinks it to be. God doesn't test anyone, He only provides man with opportunities so he can judge how capable he is, and may strive to do better.

In surah *Ad-Dahar*, the Quran has used the word “اِبْتَلَى” (*ibtela*), from which the meaning of latent capabilities becoming evident. It says that the human birth takes place due to the interaction of the male and female. The sperm is composed of such minute germs that they cannot even be seen without a microscope, but the whole human child is hidden in those tiny germs.

To explain this truth the Quran says:

76:2	we give birth (initiate the birth) of Man with a mixed sperm and arrange it, so in the womb its latent capabilities gets developed and he grows into a seeing and hearing human child	إِنَّا خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ نُّطْفَةٍ أَمْشَاجٍ نَّبْتَلِيهِ فَجَعَلْنَاهُ سَمِيعًا بَصِيرًا
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This is what “اِبْتِلَاءٌ” (*ibtelaa*) is and its correct definition is for latent elements to become evident and grow.

Bala بَلَى

“بَلَى” (*bala*) is used if the question is negative, so it can refute it.

7:172	Am I not your Sustainer?	أَلَسْتُ بِرَبِّكُمْ
7:172	They said, yes off course, we testify to that.	قَالُوا بَلَى شَهِدْنَا

This means that they are actually saying “You are our Sustainer”.

43:80	Do they think that We are unaware of their secrets and private discussions?	أَمْ يَحْسِبُونَ أَنَّا لَا نَسْمَعُ سِرَّهُمْ وَنَجْوَاهُمْ
43:80	But yes, our messengers are with them, writing it all down	بَلَى وَرُسُلُنَا لَدَيْهِمْ يَكْتُبُونَ

And the answer is “بَلَى” (*bala*) why not? We definitely are (aware).

There may not be any question, and refutation of something negative is meant. For instance:

16:38	They swear, and swear profusely by Allah that one who dies is not resurrected by Allah (but they are totally wrong)	وَأَقْسَمُوا بِاللَّهِ جَهْدَ أَيْمَانِهِمْ لَا يَبْعَثُ اللَّهُ مَنْ يَمُوتُ
16:38	But yes, He has made a binding promise (law), but people are not aware.	بَلَى وَعَدْنَا عَلَيْهِ حَقًّا وَلَكِنْ أَكْثَرُ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ

This is His promise (His law) that there will be life after death, and this promise will be fulfilled by all counts. Here, “بَلَى” (*bala*) refutes the first part of the sentence.

Similarly, surah *Al-Baqrah* says that the Jews and the Christians say that none other than their people will go to Heaven. After this, it is said:

2:112	No, this is wrong. The fact is that anyone who bows to the laws of Allah (The Quran) can go to Heaven	بَلَى مَنْ أَسْلَمَ وَجْهَهُ لِلَّهِ وَهُوَ مُحْسِنٌ فَلَهُ أَجْرُهُ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِ وَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ
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B-L-Y ب ل ي

“بَلَى يَبْلَى يَبْلَى” (*yabliya yabla balius saub*): that the cloth became old and fragile. Any cloth which has become old and fragile will be called “بَالٍ” (*baalin*) {T}.

The Quran says:

20:120	Such government that does not diminish or deteriorate. (a state which always stays fresh and which does not deteriorate)	مُلْكٍ لَا يَبْلَى
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Every human being nurses the wish to live forever and become immortal. In its own particular way, the Quran states that this hope was exploited by *Iblees* who was told that:

20:120	Shall I tell you, Adam, about immortality and point out a state which never gets old?	قَالَ يَا آدَمُ هَلْ أَذِلُّكَ عَلَى شَجَرَةِ الْخُلْدِ وَمُلْكٍ لَا يَبْلَى
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Then through discreet pointers, the Quran tells about the idea planted by *Iblees* that immortality could only be possible through one’s children (progeny), ergo a man should try to keep his name alive. But this is an *Ibleesian* misconception. Eternal life is only possible through development of man’s personality for which the Quran has given a specific program (it includes to have *Imaan* and do righteous deeds). It is true that one’s dynasty is essential for extending one’s race, but this doesn’t produce growth in the individual’s personality. Those who exist on the level of animals think that this (the progeny) is the key to immortality.

“بَنُّ بِالْمَكَانِ” (*banu bilmakan*), “بَبْنِي” (*babni*), “بَنَاءٌ” (*ban’aa*): to stay foot somewhere, to stop.

“أَبْنَتِ السَّحَابَةُ” (*abannatis sahaba*): the cloud remained at a spot for several days.

“تَبَنَّ” (*tabannana*): he stayed put.

“الْبَنَانِي” (*al-banani*): the fingers, or their environs {T}, because it is the fingers with which one hold something strongly. It is a fact that the thumb is a strong element for holding something tightly, which is why this word is used for human strength, the power to grasp, and strong grip.

Surah *Al-anfaal* says:

8:12	hit every <i>banan</i> of theirs	وَاضْرِبُوا مِنْهُمْ كُلَّ بَنَانٍ
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Here the word *banan* means “fingers”. The meaning is to hit everything which signifies the enemy’s power and strength.

Surah *Al-Qiyamah* says:

75:4	We can also complete all of Man’s limbs and strengths	بَلَى قَادِرِينَ عَلَى أَنْ نُسَوِّيَ بَنَانَهُ
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This means to complete every such thing with which he grabs other things, or all those strengths which are responsible for human acts.

Ibn Faris says that *banan* means hands and legs.

“بَنَاءٌ” (*bnaa*): a building, or anything that is constructed, even the tents in which the Arab gypsies live. It also means a roof. *Abu Hanifa* thinks “بِنَاءٌ” (*binnaa*): anything which is inorganic, like stone, earth etc.

“بَنَّاءٌ” (*banna*) is a constructor, as well as an architect.

“بَانٍ” (*banin*) also means constructor of a building. Its plural is “بَنَاءَةٌ” (*bunah*).

“بَانِيَّةٌ” (*baaniah*) is the bent bone of the chest.

“بُنْيَانٌ” (*buniyan*): walls. Some think that this word is plural.

“بَنِيَّةٌ” (*baniyah*) is the form of construction:

“أَرْضٌ مَبْنِيَّةٌ” (*ardun maniyah*): land on which a building is constructed {T, L}.

Ibn Faris says this root means to build by linking a part of one thing to another.

“إِبْنٌ” (*Ibn*): man’s son, because a son is in a way a father’s construction as well, or because a son has some part of the father in him. The plural is “أَبْنَاءٌ” (*abna’a*), or “بَنُونَ” (*banoon*), or “بَنِينٌ” (*baneen*).

“بِنْتُ” (*bint*) is the daughter of which “بَنَاتٌ” (*banat*) is plural.

“تَبَنَّى” (*tabannah*): to adopt someone as one’s son. It also means having interest or relations with someone, for example “إِبْنُ حَرْبٍ” (*ibn herb*) is a fighter. “إِبْنُ السَّبِيلِ” (*ibnas sabeel*) is a passenger {R}.

The Quran says:

2:22	Who spread the earth below you and the sky above	الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ فِرَاشًا وَالسَّمَاءَ بِنَاءً
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Here “بَنَاءٌ” (*bina’aa*): something which is laid down, so “بِنَاءٌ” (*bina’aa*) would mean something which is hovering above or spread out above, like a tent.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:26	Allah made their constructions fall on them from their foundations, and their roofs caved in over them	فَأَتَى اللَّهُ بُنْيَانَهُمْ مِنَ الْقَوَاعِدِ فَخَرَّ عَلَيْهِمُ السَّقْفُ
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Here “بُنْيَانٌ” (*bunyaan*): buildings which have foundations beneath and roofs above.

In the tale about the *Bani Israel*, the word of “أَبْنَاءُ” (*ibna*) has been used against “نِسَاءُ” (*nisa*).

14:6	They used to <i>qatal</i> (degrade) your <i>Ibna</i> and "kept alive" your <i>nisa</i>	وَيَذَّبَحُونَ أَبْنَاءَهُمْ وَيَسْتَحْيُونَ نِسَاءَهُمْ
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If “أَبْنَاءُ” (*abna*) is to be translated as sons, then “نِسَاءُ” (*nisa*) should mean daughters, and if “أَبْنَاءُ” (*abna*) is taken to mean men, then “نِسَاءُ” (*nisa*) would mean women. These meanings are also supported by verse 17:40 where “نِسَاءُ” (*nisa*) has been used against “بَنِينَ” (*baneen*). Figuratively “أَبْنَاءُ” (*abna*) would mean the strong or well-constructed individuals of a society. Also see under heading (N-S-W) and (Dh-B-Ain).

Surah *Al-Luqman* says “يَا بُنَيَّ” (*ya bunaiya*) in 39:16 which means, “O my little son”. Here “بُنَيَّ” (*bunaiyun*) is the abbreviated form of “ابْنٌ” (*ibn*).

Bani Israel

بنی اسرائیل

Bani Israel are the descendants of *Israel* or *Yaqoob*.

This was the title for *Yaqoob* who was *Ibrahim*’s grandson. *Israel* means “Man of God”. His progeny or dynasty is called *Bani Israel*.

His fourth son was named *Yahuda* (Judas). The tribe of *Yahuda* and *Bin Yamin* ruled *Judea* in *Palestine*. That is why the tribe was called *Yahudi* (which is even today the word a Jew) and the other tribes were called *Bani Israel*. Later, the difference mitigated and they both came to be identified as *Bani Israel*.

Yaqoob’s motherland was *Kana’aan* (Palestine), but when his son *Yusuf* attained a lofty position in Egypt, the entire family was called to Egypt, due to it being *Yusuf*’s tribe, who was most respected in Egypt. For four hundred years, the tribe remained in Egypt, and the tribe which was comprised of a few individuals became a big nation. But at the same time the pharaohs of Egypt enslaved them and treated them like slaves are treated, which is shabbily. When their ignominy reached its peak, *Moosa* was sent to them (as a messenger) and he, after liberating them from the enslavement of the pharaohs, took them back to Palestine. This event happened close to 1600 B.C. Here they reached new heights. They were also blessed with exalted messengers like *Daud* and *Suleman*. But then this nation became mutinous of Allah’s laws, and this resulted in chaos which made them weaker and weaker as a nation.

In 599 B.C. *Babul*’s (Babylon’s) king, *Banu Kid Naser* (Nebuchadnezzar) attacked Jerusalem and ransacked this national center of *Yahudis* (Jews). They were imprisoned and taken to *Babul* where they lived in ignominy. The Quran has pointed to this first devastation of the Jews in verse 17:5. For nearly eighty years, they lived in this sorry state when three kings, *Zulqarnain* (Cyrus), *Dara* (Darius) and *Artakhshasha* (Artaxerxes) became ready to help them one after another. They deliberated them from the imprisonment in Babylon and allowed them to resettle once again in Palestine around 515 BC. Palestine was then rebuilt and the expelled Jews settled in their center again. The Quran has pointed to this in verse 17:6 and placed this (nearly) 100 years’ period in allegorical form. Some years later, the Jews reverted to their degenerated state. In year 332 BC first Alexander attacked them and dispersed them. Later, in year 320 BC *Batlemoos* (Ptolemy) captured Jerusalem and broke whatever power they had left.

During Antigonos’ rule, the whole area came under the Greeks. Then in 66 BC Pompeii (a Roman) destroyed Jerusalem in 01 BC. Another attack on Jerusalem completely destroyed their morale (the Quran has pointed to this second destruction of the Jews in verse 17:7).

At this stage, Nature gave them another chance to recuperate, and *Isa* (Jesus) was sent to them, but the Jewish scholars and leaders hatched a conspiracy against him and in this way self-destructed.

In 70 A.D, the Roman governor Tyson attacked them for the last time due to which there was no trace left of them. In the words of *Encyclopedia Britannica*:

“On the tenth of the month in 70 A.D, in a state of fear which is without parallel in the world, the fall of Jerusalem took place, and the Jewish state was no more.”

As to why the Jewish scholars and leaders had conspired against *Isa*, the following statement from the gospel of Barnabas can throw light. On page 142 of Barnabas’ Bible it is said:

“Then they discussed with the leaders of the astrologers and said,”If this Man (Christ) becomes king, what are we then going to do? It will be a big difficulty for us. Because he wants to reform the way God is worshipped. At this moment he doesn’t hold the power to annul our practices and traditions, but (if he comes into power) what will happen to us under his control? Surely we and our children will all be destroyed, because the moment we lose our position, we will have to beg for our bread. Although at this time the king and our ruler are both without any care about what we do, as we also do not have anything to do with their practices. That is why we can do whatever we please. At this time, if we make any mistake, we can please our God with fasting and sacrifice, but if this man (Christ) becomes king, God will not be pleased until he finds worship to be what Moses has written”.

Such a nation, which has degenerated to this level, has no other fate than destruction and ignominy. During the time of our Messenger *Muhammed*, they (the Jews) were given another opportunity to redeem themselves by obeying the laws of Allah, but due to their dogmatism, they opposed this too and as a result had to leave the Arab peninsula. The Quran has mentioned this in verse 59:2, thereafter this nation was known as the **“Wandering Jews”** till such time (now) that the political reformers of some strong states have made a home for them in Palestine. (We will not go into this political discussion because it is outside our scope)

It must be noted that religion among the Jews was only hereditary or national. One could only be a Jew by dint birth into a Jew family. None other than one of **Bani Israel** could be a Jew. This alone is enough to show that this was not the religion which had been given to them by the messengers. Allah’s **Deen** (system) is for the entire human race. That is why when the advisors of Pharaoh’s court accepted **Imaan** (became believers), they were not rejected by **Moosa** because they were not from among the **Bani Israel** (i.e. the dynasty of **Jacob**). But later, the Jews made it a national religion. More details about the **Bani Israel** can be found in my book **“Barq-e-Toor”**.

B-He-T ب ه ت

“بَهِتَ” (**bahit**) is to be shocked or surprised. It means to be quieted due to surprise.
 “الْبَهْتُ” (**al-bahto**) is to catch someone suddenly.

The Quran says:

2:258	He who had denied, was grabbed by this ultimate reasoning, (due to surprise he became quiet, he shut up as he was shocked)	فَبَهِتَ الَّذِي كَفَرَ
21:40	the revolution will come so suddenly that it will stun them	فَتَبْهَتُهُمْ

“بُهْتَانٌ” (**bohtan**) is to accuse someone, at which he becomes shocked, as in 24:16

24:12	Clearly false talk	إِنَّكَ مُبِينٌ
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Surah **Al-Mumtehana** uses this word “بُهْتَانٌ” (**bohtan**) as every unpleasant act:

60:12	and will not commit any unpleasant act	وَلَا يَأْتِيَنَّ بِبُهْتَانٍ يَفْتَرِينَهُ
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“الْبَهْجَةُ” (*al-bahjah*) means “beauty”. This word is used for freshness and bloom in vegetation and pleasantness in humans.

“الْإِبْتِهَاجُ” (*al-ibtehaaj*): happiness and pleasure.

“تَبَاهَجَ الرُّوضُ” (*tabahajar-rauz*): a lot of flowers bloomed in the garden.

The Quran says:

22:5	and the earth gives birth to (grows) every kind of fresh and delightful plant	وَأَنْبَتَتْ مِنْ كُلِّ نَفْجٍ هَبَّحٍ
27:60	Beautiful gardens	حَدَائِقَ ذَاتَ بَهْجَةٍ

“الْبَهْلَةُ” (*abhalah*): to make someone free in his opinion and intent.

“الْبَهْلُ النَّاقَةُ” (*abhan naqa*): that the camel was set free so that anyone could milk it, or she was allowed to roam free.

“إِسْتَبْهَلَ الْوَالِي الرِّعْيَةَ” (*istabhal al way-alir raeeyah*): that the ruler let the subjects go free so they could do whatever that suited them {T}.

Raghib says that the actual meaning of the word is to leave something in an unattended state, to leave it to its own device. **Raghib** also says that

“الْإِبْتِهَالُ فِي الدُّعَاءِ” (*al-ibtehal-o fid dua yi*): to openly keep on praying for something {R}.

“الْبَهْلُ مِنَ الْمَالِ” (*albahl-o minal maal*): a little wealth

“الْبَهْلُ” (*al-bahal*) is a little something, an insignificant amount {T}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning includes water shortage.

This word has appeared in 3:60 where the Messenger is told that if these people do not accept (what you preach) despite all the reasoning and evidence, then tell them that we and our family gets to one side and you and your families move to another. “ثُمَّ نَبْتَهِلْ” (*summa nabtahil*).

And thus Quran says:

3:60	From now you don't interfere in our society, and we have nothing to do with you	فَنَجْعَلُ لَعْنَةَ اللَّهِ عَلَى الْكَاذِبِينَ
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In other words, leave each another in order to choose and operate separate opinions and beliefs, and follow their respective programs. Time and result will make it clear which group gets deprived of Allah's blessing and becomes “ملعون” (*mal'oon*).

This is what “لعنة” (*lana*) means, that the deprived group will be proven false in its claims. This is said at different places as:

73:10	leave them in a very nice manner	وَأَهْجُرْهُمْ هَجْرًا جَمِيلًا
15:85	So be in a very nice manner	فَاصْصَحِ الصَّصْحَ الْجَمِيلَ
3:136	You pursue your way and I will pursue mine, results shall declare successes and failure	أَعْمَلُوا عَلَى مَكَانَتِكُمْ إِنِّي عَامِلٌ فَسَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ مَنْ تَكُونُ لَهُ عَاقِبَةُ الدَّارِ إِنَّهُ لَا يُفْلِحُ الظَّالِمُونَ

This will also prove the law of Allah which dictates that “the fields of disbelievers never produce a crop”. This is what Allah's *lana* on the liars is.

The first revolutionary step in a Messenger's program is of preaching. The second step is to distance from those who refuse to accept the program and oppose it due to their intransigence and adamancy. At this

stage they are told simply not to interfere in the messenger's program and the Messenger will not interfere in their affairs. This has been termed as “نَبْأَهُلْ” (*nabtahil*) in surah *Aal-e-Imran*. The third stage is of the clash when results are before everyone to see. In other words, good and evil are made evident irrefutably.

B-He-M ب ه م

“الْبُهْمَةُ” (*al-bohma*): a solid rock.
 “الْأَبْهَمُ” (*al-abhamo*): solid and composite thing, dumb, ambiguous, without flow.
 “بُهْمَةٌ” (*bohma*): a matter which is difficult to understand.
 “إِبْهَامًا الْأَمْرُ إِبْهَامًا” (*abhamal amro ibhama*): that the matter became ambiguous and was beyond comprehension as how to solve it.
 “حَائِظٌ مُبْهَمٌ” (*ha-i-zun mubhamun*): a wall which has no opening or door {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is for something to become such that no way towards it is perceived or to become indistinct and ambiguous.

With reference to dumbness, “بَهَائِمٌ” (*baha-um*), singular of which is “الْبَيْهِيمُ” (*al-baheema*), means all animals who cannot speak, or their voices are ambiguous and they cannot be understood. All animals including aquatic animals are included in this category. However, *Muheet* and *Raghib* both maintain that wild carnivores and birds are not included in this category.

The Quran says:

5:1	<i>bahimatul anam</i> (dumb animals) have been made <i>halal</i> (permitted) for you...	أُحِلَّتْ لَكُمْ بَهِيمَةُ الْأَنْعَامِ إِلَّا مَا يُتْلَى عَلَيْكُمْ
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... other than those which the Quran itself has termed as *haram* (forbidden) in 5:3. For the meanings see heading (*N-Ain-M*).

B-W-A ب و أ

“بَاءٌ” (*baa'a*), “يُبَوِّءُ” (*yabu-o*), “بَوَّاءٌ” (*bawaa*) basically means to return to something, to move back, to be in agreement with, to accept, to bear the load, to be equal {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

2:61	they became prone to Allah's wrath and with that burden returned	وَبَاؤُوا بِغَضَبٍ مِّنَ اللَّهِ
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Their actions and the resulting ignominy became befitting.

In surah *Al-Maida*, in the tale about the descendants of Adam, it is said that the oppressed said to the oppressor:

5:29	I want that you bear the burden of my murder and other crimes. (Become deserving of their punishment.)	إِنِّي أُرِيدُ أَنْ نَبْنِيءَ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَكَ
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“الْمَبَاءُ” (*al-maba'ah*): bee hive. It also means residence, home {*T*}.
 “بَوَّاءَ الْمَكَانِ” (*bowwal makana*): he stopped somewhere, got down.
 “بَوَّاءَ الْمَنْزِلِ” (*bowwahul manzil*): got him down somewhere, got him to stay somewhere.
 “بَوَّاءَ هُ مَنْزِلًا” (*bowwahul manzila*): he made some place agreeable, corrected some place, and made it smooth {*T*}.

Raghib too says it means “to make the elements of some place smooth and agreeable”.

“بَوَّأْتُ لَهُ مَكَانًا” (*bawwatu lahu makanah*): I made some place smooth for him.

Surah *Al-Hajj* says:

22:26	We appointed the <i>Kaba</i> to be the smooth place for him	وَأَذْبَحُوا لَنَا فِي هَيْمٍ مَّكَانَ الْبَيْتِ
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It can also mean that “We made it a place to be returned to, for him”.

“تَبَوَّأَ الْمَكَانَ” (*tabawwal makan*) got down at some place and stayed there {*T, M, R*}

Surah *Al-Hashar* says:

59:9	Those who made <i>Medina</i> their abode (staying place) before them, and placed strong trust in their hearts.	وَالَّذِينَ تَبَوَّأُوا الدَّارَ وَالْإِيمَانَ مِنْ قَبْلِهِمْ
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B-W-B

ب و ب

“بَابٌ” (*baab*) is the place of entry {*T*}, hence it means “a door”. Plural is “أَبْوَابٌ” (*abwaab*). In agriculture the places from where water is opened (allowed to flow) are also called “أَبْوَابٌ” (*abwaab*) {*M*}.

“هَذَا بَابُهُ” (*haaza babatohu*): this is befitting, this suits him, or is his condition {*T*}.

“أَبْوَابُ السَّمَاءِ” (*abwaabus sama'a*) as used in 7:39 means “the paths of blessings”.

“أَبْوَابُ جَهَنَّمَ” (*abwaaba jahannum*) as used in 16:29, means “the stages of destruction”. Also see 15:44.

“أَبْوَابُ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*abwaabo kulli shaiyi*) in 6:44 means “every type of comfort”.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* has used “ظُهُورَهَا” (*zahooraha*) against it in 2:128 to mean “backyard” against “the doors of a house”.

B-W-R

ب و ر

“الْبُورُ” (*al-baur*) is the land which has not been cultivated, ergo uncultivable land.

“بَارَ عَمَلَهُ” (*baar amaloh*): his actions went waste {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are annihilation and suspension.

The Quran says:

35:10	their planning will go waste (will bear no fruit)	وَمَكْرُؤٌ كُفِّرْتُمْ وَهُوَ يَبُورُ
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“بَارَتِ السُّوقُ” (*baaratis sooq*): the market cooled down (went into a depression) {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

35:29	a trade which sees no loss	بِجَارَةٍ لَّنْ تَبُورَ
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“الْبُورُ” (*al-boor*): useless, without benefit, idle, losers, those who are to be destroyed {*T*}.

25:18	That nation was to be annihilated.	وَكَانُوا قَوْمًا بُورًا
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“الْبَوَارُ” (*al-bawar*): destruction, loss

“بَوَارُ الْأَيِّمِ” (*bawarul aleem*) is an unmarried girl or widow not being married (and staying home) because there are no proposals for her.

The Quran says:

14:28	they brought their nation to a place where there would be no buyer for that commodity	وَأَحَلُّوا قَوْمَهُمْ دَارَ الْبَوَارِ
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This means where nobody even inquires about them, where nobody gives them any message, where they are in great loss, where there is destruction and annihilation for them. Due to vested interests and wrong policies of leaders, nations reach such a state. This has been termed as *jahannum* by the Quran in 14:29.

The full verses' translation is as following: "have you pondered about those who defied Allah and led the nation to a state where there was no buyer for them (the commodity) i.e. **jahannum**, or a place of destruction, and they entered it, and it is a lousy (bad) place to stay at". The leaders that do not value the blessings of Allah lead their nations to **jahannum** of destruction and annihilation, where both the leaders and the nation meet destruction.

The Quran has stated the dialogue between these leaders and their nations in detail and they are very eye opening in 14:21, 33:67, 37:29, 40:47, and 38:60.

B-W-L ب و ل

"أَلْبَالُ" (**al-baal**) is the condition or state about which one should ponder, i.e. a valuable matter which captures one's fantasy, wishes, emotions, thoughts that cross one's mind {T}.

Surah **Yusuf** says:

12:50	What is the condition of those women? (What is the matter with them?)	مَا بَالُ النِّسْوَةِ
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"بَالُ" (**baal**): that the matter had particular importance. **Yusuf** was worried about some matter in the above mentioned verse.

Surah **Muhammed** says:

47:2	God will smoothen out their difficulties, sort out their problems.	وَأَصْلَحَ بَالَهُمْ
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B-Y-T ب ي ت

Raghib says that "بَيْتُ" (**bait**): a place where a man takes shelter for the night, but later this word came to mean "a house".

"بَيْتُ الرَّجُلِ" (**baitur rajul**): a man's wife and kids.

"أَلْبَيْتُ" (**al-bait**): to wed {T}.

"بَاتُ" (**baat**), "بَيْتُ" (**yabeet**): to work all night long.

Zajaj says that anyone who spends the night some place is "بَاتُ" (**baat**), whether he sleeps or does some work there.

"بَيْتُ الْأَمْرِ" (**baitul amr**): to plan work at night, or to work at night.

"بَيْتُ الْقَوْمِ" (**bayyatal qaum**) is to attack a nation at night {T}.

"أَلْبَيْتُ" (**al-beet**): food.

"أَلْبَايْتُ" (**al-ba-it**) is stale, (not fresh).

Surah **Al-Baqrah** uses "أَلْبَيْتُ" (**al-baito**) for the **Ka'ba** in 2:125.

Surah **Al-Furqan** uses "يَبْتَثُونَ" (**yabeetoon**) in 25:64, which means to consult at night, or to spend the night, while its use in 27:49 indicates to mean attack at night.

"بَيَّاتًا" (**bayata**): during the night.

“بَادَ يَبِيدُ” (*bada yabeed*): for something to diminish, to end, to be annihilated.

“بَادَتِ الشَّمْسُ بُيُودًا” (*baadatis shamsu buyuda*): the sun set.

“الْبَيْدَاءُ” (*al-baida*): to travel in a barren desert or jungle, meaning annihilation.

“بَادَ السَّيِّءُ” (*baadash shaiyi*): that thing was scattered. From this it has come to mean to diminish or to be destroyed.

“إِبَادَهُ اللَّهُ” (*abadah-ullah*): Allah annihilated him {*T, R*}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:35	I never thought that it would be destroyed	مَا أَظُنُّ أَنْ تَبِيدَ هَذِهِ أَبَدًا
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“الْبَائِدُ” (*al-bayed*): one who is annihilated {*M*}.

“الْأَبْيَضُ” (*al-abyaz*): white. Plural is “بَيْضٌ” (*beez*) and feminine is “بَيْضَاءُ” (*baizaa*).

“الْبَيَاضُ” (*al-bayaz*): whiteness. It is the opposite of “الْأَسْوَدُ” (*aswad*) and means black {*T*}.

As for the Arabs, “بَيَاضٌ” (*bayaz*) was the best regarded color. Therefore it is allegorical to good habits and blessings. As such, a man who is not soiled with any defects is called “الْأَبْيَضُ الْوَجْهَ” (*abyazul wajhi*). It also means life’s brightness and life’s happiness.

The Quran says:

3:105	on that day some faces will be white and some black	يَوْمَ تَبْيَضُّ وُجُوهٌ وَتَسْوَدُّ وُجُوهٌ
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Here “تَبْيِضُ” (*tabyazzo*): to be blessed with life’s happiness.

“تَسْوَدُّ” (*taswaddo*): pain and sorrow {*M*}.

“الْبَيْضَةُ” (*al-baizato*): egg, also the status or real place of anything, gathering, collective force, basis, the place of government or domination, group or tribe {*T*}.

“الْيَدُ الْبَيْضَاءُ” (*al-yadul baiza'o*): the argument which forms the basis of some reasoning, or clear and evident reasoning, also a person who do not dwell upon or stress the philanthropy after giving something. The one who gives without even asking {*T*}.

Muheet says it means blessing, power, pride and fame {*M*}.

The Quran mentions “يَدُ بَيْضَاءَ” (*yad eybaize*) several times, as in the tale of Moses (7:107, 20:22, 26:34, and 28:32). It figuratively means clear and distinct reasoning.

Lataif-ul-lugha has also supported these meanings.

About the women in *jannah*, the Quran says:

37:49	consider them to be like preserved “eggs”	كَأَنَّهُنَّ بَيْضٌ مَكْنُونٌ
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This means white, without blemish, without any defect and shiny pearls.

55:58	As if they are <i>yaqoot</i> and <i>marjan</i> (rubies and pearls) (virgins whom nobody has touched earlier)	كَأَنَّهُنَّ الْيَاقُوتُ وَالْمَرْجَانُ
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“إِبْيَضَتْ” (*ibyazatto*) or “بَيَّضَتْ” (*bayyizat*): to be filled.

“إِبْيَضَتْ عَيْنَاهُ” (*ibyazzat ainah*): his eyes filled with tears {*Razi*}.

About *Yaqoob*, surah *Yusuf* says:

12:84	his eyes were always full of tears due to sorrow	وَابْيَضَّتْ عَيْنَاهُ مِنَ الْحُزَنِ
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“بَاعَ” (*baa*), “بَيْعَ” (*yabeeh*), “بَيْعًا” (*bai’a*): either to sell or buy something.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:254	The day there shall not be any buying or selling	يَوْمَ لَا بَيْعٌ فِيهِ
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The surah goes on to say:

2:257	Allah has declared <i>bai’a</i> as <i>halal</i> (permitted) and <i>riba</i> as haram (prohibited)	وَأَحَلَّ اللَّهُ الْبَيْعَ وَحَرَّمَ الرِّبَا
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Further ahead where laws about trade are given, it is said:

2:282	in case of cash dealing, there is no need to write it down	أَنْ تَكُونَ تِجَارَةً حَاضِرَةً
2:282	when it is a matter of mutual dealing of buying and selling, then have some witnesses (and write it down as well)	وَأَشْهَدُوا إِذَا تَبَايَعْتُمْ

From the context it is evident that it is a case where the dealing is not in cash. This shows that trade and *bai’a* are different. This is supported by the verse in surah *An-Noor*:

24:37	People who trade and do <i>bai’a</i> don’t ignore Allah’s mention	رِجَالٌ لَا تُلْهِيهِمْ تِجَارَةٌ وَلَا بَيْعٌ عَنْ ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ
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In today’s language, it would mean that the difference between these two words is that “بيع” (*bai’a*) is like ordinary trading, trade or commerce {T}. Trade is professional trading while “بيع” (*bai’a*) is like barter.

Recall the verse in which it has been mentioned that Allah has declared “بيع” (*bai’a*) as *halal* and “ربو” (*riba*) as *haram*. *Riba* as interests will be dealt in detail in the relevant chapter. Here it is necessary to know what, according to the Quran, “بيع” (*bai’a*) is that we believe in it, and act accordingly which also includes the guidelines for trading. We cannot take as much profit as possible, this is not permitted.

Surah *At-Tatfeef* says:

83:1-3	Woe to them who (deliberately) give less or reduce. When they take measure from others, they take full, but when they give measure to others, they give less.	وَيْهَلٌ لِّلْمُطَفِّفِينَ الَّذِينَ إِذَا أَكْتَالُوا عَلَى النَّاسِ يَسْتَوْفُونَ وَإِذَا كَالُوهُمْ أَوْ وَزَنُوهُمْ يُخْسِرُونَ
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These verses don’t only mean that the measure or weight must be complete. These verses describe a very important principle of the Quranic system. Say one worker makes a pair of shoes and brings it to the shopkeeper. The shopkeeper tries his utmost to buy the pair of shoes at the lowest price possible,

That is, they take full measure, but do not give accordingly. When a customer approaches such a person, he tries to get the highest possible price from him. It is such trader’s mentality which the Quran has described as the reason for social destruction. This “earning” has been called “تطفيف” (*tatfeef*). Why does the shopkeeper give the lowest possible price to the workman? Or in other words, why is the worker (the cobbler in this example) compelled to sell at the lowest price? Simply because he does not have any “capital”. As such, the “profit” acquired this way on the strength of capital is not permitted.

The question now remains as to what profit the shopkeeper should get. For one thing, he employs investment; secondly he works the whole day at the shop. The rule according to the Quran is that:

53:39	for a man it is (only) what he works for	لَيْسَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ إِلَّا مَا سَعَى
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Thus this shopkeeper deserves the return for his labor, not a profit on the capital. For this, it needs to be determined as to what the shopkeeper should get for a day’s work. He cannot take more than this share out of this business.

The economics rule of the Quran's is:

2:279	you should not give anybody a loss nor should anyone give you a loss	لَا تَظْلِمُونَ وَلَا تُظْلَمُونَ
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This means that you should not commit any excess on anybody and nobody should commit any excess on you. Since there is no labor in interest, and only an interest on the capital is received, that is why only the principal amount is allowed to be taken back. In “بيع” (*bai'a*), since there is basic plus labor, therefore it is permissible to take the basic along with the compensation for the labor, not more. This will work till the whole economic system adopts the Quranic way, thereafter the entire responsibility for the necessities of life will be on society (the state) and there would be no profit taking at all.

Therefore, where capital alone fetches an earning (without any labour) will not be permitted in an Islamic society. “ربوا” (*riba*) is only with capital and “بيع” (*bai'a*) is capital plus labor. In “بيع” (*bai'a*), the compensation for labor can be earned.

“بيع” (*bai'a*) also means mutual agreement {T}. According to the Quran, there is sort of trade or “بيع” (*bai'a*) between a *Momin* and God:

9:111	Verily, Allah has traded their lives and possessions for <i>janna</i> (heaven).	إِنَّ اللَّهَ اشْتَرَى مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَنْفُسَهُمْ وَأَمْوَالَهُمْ بِأَنْ هُمْ الْجَنَّةَ
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It is obvious from this that man is actually the owner of neither his wealth, nor his life. Both things are only lent to him for safe-keeping. In return, he is granted heavenly bliss in this world as well as in the Hereafter. The details are to be found in my book *Nizaam-e-Raboobiyat*.

In reality, this pact is between Man and the central authority of the system which manifests itself to implement the laws of Allah in this world (initially with the Messenger and later on with other leaders succeeding him). This is the pact which is committed at the time of accepting Islam, as it is mentioned in surah *Al-Mumtaneha*:

60:12	O <i>Nabi</i> , when <i>Momin</i> women come to you for this pact	يَا أَيُّهَا النَّبِيُّ إِذَا جَاءَكَ الْمُؤْمِنَاتُ يُبَايِعْنَكَ
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It is renewed when this system is in great difficulties and when the *Momineen* have to come out fearlessly for battle. This was the same pact which the *Momineen* committed themselves to at *Hudaibiya* and which has been mentioned in surah *Al-Fateh* in these words:

48:10	Those who make a pact with you actually are making a pact with Allah, and apparently your hand is over theirs, but actually it is the hand of Allah.	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يُبَايِعُونَكَ إِنَّمَا يُبَايِعُونَ اللَّهَ يَدُ اللَّهِ فَوْقَ أَيْدِيهِمْ
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You see how a pact actually is made with Allah? The pact is in fact made with the system's center, which is based on the laws of Allah. This was the pact which was made in exchange for one's life and possessions, but when *Deen* (system of life) turned into religious *Sufism*, then “بيع” (*bai'a*) became a theory instead of a practical principle.

“الْبَيْعَةُ” (*al-be'a*) is the *Knesset* of the Jews or church of the Christians {T} as used in 22:40.

Latif-ul-lugha says that *Knesset* is the Jews' place for prayer and “الْبَيْعَةُ” (*al-be'a*) is the prayer place of the Christians.

According to *Allama Iqbal*:

Either continuous chanting towards emptiness of the sky	یا وسعت افلاک میں تکبیر مسلسل
Or continuous chanting while embracing the dust	یا خاک کے آغوش میں تسبیح و مناجات
That is the religion of strong men while they are lost in divine search.	وہ مذہب مردان خود آگاہ و خدا مست
This is merely the religion of priests suited for those who have no ability of progression.	یہ مذہب ملاوٹا نباتات و جمادات

“الْبَيْنُ” (*al-bain*): separation, parting, to be separate or to separate. Some linguists think that it holds the contradictory meanings of both separating and meeting, but it is a weak argument. The right usage is “فَصْلٌ” (*faslun*): to separate. *Ibn Faris* says this is what the word actually means.
 “الْبَيْنُ” (*al-baino*) is the distance between two pieces of land.
 “بَانُوا بَيْنًا” (*baanu baina*): that they parted or got separated.
 “بَانَ الشَّيْءُ” (*baanush shaiyi*): the thing was cut off, parted away.
 “ضَرَبَهُ فَأَبَانَ رَأْسَهُ” (*zarabahu fa'abaana rasahu*): “he hit him and separated his head from his shoulders”.
 “طَلَقَ بَائِنٌ” (*talaq bainun*) is the final divorce after which man and wife are separated {T}.

This is only a linguistic term, because according to the Quran “طلاق” (*talaq*) as divorce, is the ending off a contract of “نِكَاحٌ” (*nikah*), meaning marriage. See heading (*Te-L-Q*).

“بَيْنٌ” (*baina*): the center between two things {T}.
 “الْبَيَانُ” (*al-bayan*): for something to make its advent, to become clear, to appear.
 “بَيِّنَ الشَّجَرُ” (*bayyanush shajar*): leaves of a tree when they appear, like when buds etc. become evident.
 “بَيِّنَ الْقَرْنُ” (*bainul qaran*): the horn appeared.

Muheet's compiler says “بَيَّانٌ” (*bayaan*) is something with logic or reasoning which clarifies a matter. The Quran uses “تَبْيِينٌ” (*tabyeen*) against “كَتَمٌ” (*katam*) in 3:186 and 2:159. “كَتَمٌ” (*katam*): to hide something. As such, “تَبْيِينٌ” (*tabyeen*) would mean to highlight something, make it evident. At another place this word has been used against “إِخْفَاءٌ” (*ikhfaa*) which means to hide, as in 5:15. At the same place, the Quran has been called “كِتَابٌ مُبِينٌ” (*kitabun mubeen*) which means the life format which makes the hidden truths evident. It is also understood as the life's manual which contains clear truths, which are not related to this physical world and are beyond Man's comprehension. They are revealed to the Messenger by God through Revelation. To reveal the truth this way, is called “تَبْيِينٌ” (*tibyaan*).

That is why the Quranic truths are called “بَيِّنَاتٌ” (*bayyenaat*) which means the truths He has manifested Himself. If He had not disclosed them, then they would have remained hidden.

So far we have talked about the hidden truths which God has revealed to the Messenger through Revelation. Now, let us look at the next stage.

There is only one way in which God reveals the truths and it is known as revelation. Revelation is reserved for the Messenger only, but the human mind also gave birth to the concept of revelation from Allah to others than Messenger and called it “إِلْهَامٌ” (*ilhaam*) or “كَشْفٌ” (*kashaf*). For details see heading (*L-He-M*). The man can only benefit from the truths of “كَشْفٌ” (*kashaf*) or “إِلْهَامٌ” (*ilham*) on whom it appears, and they cannot be transmitted.

The Quran says that this concept is wrong. “كَشْفٌ” (*kashaf*) from God means that the truths must be made known to others. This “كَشْفٌ” (*kashaf*) is made from God through one individual (Messenger) to the whole of the human race. Whoever gets these revelations, have a duty to ponder over them and relay them to others.

This is the great truth that is mentioned in surah *An-Nahal*:

16:44	And We have revealed unto you this law of life so that what has been revealed, you may reveal to the people so that they may deliberate over it	وَأَنْزَلْنَا إِلَيْكَ الذِّكْرَ لِتُبَيِّنَ لِلنَّاسِ مَا نُزِّلَ إِلَيْهِمْ وَلَعَلَّهُمْ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ
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In other words, the Quran has said that “Allah revealed this Book to His messenger” (*anzalna ilaik*). But, in reality, this book has been revealed for all mankind “مَنْزِلَ إِلَيْهِمْ” (*ma unzela ilaihim*). Therefore, it is the Messengers duty (not to keep it to him as was wrongly believed in the case of *kashaf* and *ilham*), but to make it known to all mankind “تُبَيِّنَ لِلنَّاسِ” (*letubayyena lin naas*), and to take it to them “بَلِّغْ مَا أَنْزَلَ إِلَيْكَ مِنْ رَبِّكَ” (*baligh ma unzela ilaika mir rabbik*) (5:67). Fie upon those who hide it.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:159	Those who hide what we have openly or with guidance revealed, after that We have made it known to all in the Quran, they deserve God's <i>laana</i> and <i>laana</i> of all those who do <i>laana</i> .	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَكْتُمُونَ مَا أَنزَلْنَا مِنَ الْبَيِّنَاتِ وَالْهُدَىٰ مِنْ بَعْدِ مَا بَيَّنَّاهُ لِلنَّاسِ فِي الْكِتَابِ أُولَٰئِكَ يَلْعَنُهُمُ اللَّهُ وَيَلْعَنُهُمُ اللَّاعِنُونَ
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For the meaning of *laana*, see heading (*L-Ain-N*). It follows that:

2:160	But those people who gave this act up, and reformed, and made evident or disclosed (whatever we had revealed), these are the people who I return to	إِلَّا الَّذِينَ تَابُوا وَأَصْلَحُوا وَبَيَّنُّوا فَأُولَٰئِكَ أَتُوبُ عَلَيْهِمْ وَأَنَا التَّوَّابُ الرَّحِيمُ
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The Book that was revealed to the Messenger (The Quran) was said to have the following characteristics.

16:89	We have revealed this Book to you to clarify all matters	وَنَزَّلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ بَيِّنَاتٍ لِّكُلِّ شَيْءٍ
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In other words, all was revealed through Revelation, and nothing in this context was to remain hidden.

At another place, it is said:

2:187	This way God reveals His orders for the people so that they may observe them.	كَذَٰلِكَ يُبَيِّنُ اللَّهُ آيَاتِهِ لِلنَّاسِ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَتَّقُونَ
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As such, this is the portrayal of the truth for all mankind:

3:138	This is a clarification for all humanity	هَٰذَا بَيَانٌ لِّلنَّاسِ
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The Right and Wrong paths have both been made clear and distinct in it:

5:15	This is the completely clear and distinct book	كِتَابٌ مُّبِينٌ
15:79	This is the completely clear and distinct path	إِمَامٌ مُّبِينٌ

It is (a beacon of) light:

5:15	surely you received <i>noor</i> (light) from Allah and a clear Book	فَدَجَاءَكُمْ مِنَ اللَّهِ نُورٌ وَكِتَابٌ مُّبِينٌ
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Light is not dependent on anything else to manifest itself. It is intrinsically, and anyone who uses his intellect can illuminate other things with this light. It makes every other thing very clear, that is why it is also called “تَفْصِيلٌ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*tafseela kulli shjayi*) in 12:111.

“تَفْصِيلٌ” (*tafseel*): in detail, to display clearly by separating everything. See heading (*F-Sd-L*).

This is the truth about the Quran which has been given to mankind by God, through His Messenger. At the same time, He made it known as to what the Quranic method of “تَبْيِينٌ” (*tabyeen*) or explaining is.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:105	In this manner, We repeat things so that they say that you have clearly expostulated everything, and so that We disclose them to those who use their knowledge	وَكَذَٰلِكَ نُصَرِّفُ الْآيَاتِ لِيُبْلِغُوا دَرَجَاتٍ وَلِيُبَيِّنَهُ لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ
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In other words, the Quran can be understood with the help of deliberation and knowledge.

“الْبَيِّنَةُ” (*al-bayyinah*): reasoning which can be felt logically {*T*}. The plural form is “بَيِّنَاتٌ” (*bayyinaat*).

The Quran mentions one characteristic of man as “عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ” (*allamahul bayaan*) in 55:3. This means that God has endowed him with the ability to express his thoughts. In other words, Man has the ability to communicate with others through his tongue or pen. This ability discriminates man from other animals, and is a great tool when forming human civilization and evolving.

“بَيْنَ” (*bain*): to be in between.

2:113	God decides between them	فَاللَّهُ يَحْكُمُ بَيْنَهُمْ
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For “بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ” (*baina yadeehi*), see heading (*Y-D-Y*).

“اِسْتَبَانَ الْأَمْرُ” (*istabanal amr*): that the matter broke open, became detailed and clear.

The Quran says:

6:55	This is how we clarify the indications to the path of criminals or wrongdoers	وَكَذَلِكَ نَفْصِّلُ الْآيَاتِ لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ سَبِيلَ الْمُجْرِمِينَ
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“تَبَيَّنَ الشَّيْءُ” (*tabayyenush shaiyi*): that the thing became evident and distinct.

“تَبَيَّنْتُ” (*tabayyantehu*): that I opened it, made it evident and comprehended it, as used in 49:6.

21:57	Swear by Allah.	تَاللّٰهِ
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Al-Sualibi writes in *Fiqh-ul-Lugha* that “تاء” (*ta*) is not used except with Allah's names.

“يَا أَبَتِ” (*ya abat*) appears several places in the Quran, and means “*O my father*”, as in 14:2. Here this letter has been used as “يَ” (*yah*). This is exclusive with “*ab*”.

Taboot

تَابُوتٌ

“تَابُوتٌ” (*taboot*) means “box”, as in 20:39 {*T*}.

Raghib says it also means “the heart” and “chest”.

Lissan-ul-Arab supports this opinion, as it has been used in 2:248. Accordingly, it would mean such a heart which is full of peace and contentment and has the support of the universal forces (*malaikah*), so that it stays stable.

Taloot was endowed with such a heart, and if figurative meanings are not attributed to this word, then it would mean the coffin which the Bible mentions.

Some think that it has come from “تَابٌ” (*tab*). See heading (T-W-B).

T-B-B

ت ب ب

“الْتَّبُ” (*at-tub*): loss.

“الْتَّبَابُ” (*at-tabaabo*), “الْتَّبَيْبُ” (*at-tabeebo*), “الْتَّتْبَيْبُ” (*at-tatbeebo*): loss, annihilation and destruction {*T*}.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:101	it only increased their loss (increased their destruction)	وَمَا زَادُوهُمْ غَيْرَ تَتْبِيبٍ
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Surah *Al-Momin* says:

40:37	And whatever <i>Firoun</i> planned, was nothing else then destruction	وَمَا كَيْدُ فِرْعَوْنَ إِلَّا فِي تَبَابٍ
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“تَبَّ فُلَانًا” (*tubba fulana*): he killed that man.

“اسْتَتَبَّ الرَّجُلُ” (*istatabbar rajal*): the man became weak and old, became unable {*T*}.

“الْتَّابُ” (*at-taab*): old and weak man, camel or donkey whose back has become bent, which makes him/it unable to work {*T*}.

The Quran says:

111:1	<i>Abu Lahab's</i> both hands were destroyed and he too was annihilated	تَبَّتْ يَدَا أَبِي لَهَبٍ وَتَبَّ
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He was himself destroyed and the system due to which he opposed Allah's system was destroyed as well. He became unable to oppose, was destroyed, and encountered great loss. In *Raghib's* words, "was in continuous loss".

”التَّبَرُّ“ (*at-tibr*): gold. Some say this word is also used for silver as well as gold, especially if they are in ore form and not purified.

”التَّبَرُّ“ (*at-tabr*): to break, to annihilate {T}. Ibn Faris has recorded these two meanings for this word as well.

25:39	We turned them into pieces, annihilated them, and destroyed them.	وَكَلَّا تَبَرَّنَا تَتَبَرًّا
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”تَبَارَأَ“ (*tabara*): annihilation as used in 71:28.

”مُتَبَرَّرٌ“ (*mutabbar*): annihilated, destroyed, and turned to pieces (all as adjectives) in 7:139.

”تَبِعَ“ (*ta'beh*): to walk behind, follow.

”بَقَرَةٌ مُتَبِعَةٌ“ (*baqaratun mutbeh*): a cow which has its calf walking behind it (following it), and the following calf is called ”تَبِيعٌ“ (*tabeeh*).

”التَّبَاعُ“ (*at-tabah*): those who follow. It is the plural of ”تَابِعٌ“ (*taabeh*).

”أَتَّبَعْتُهُ“ (*atba'tum*): I followed him, he had gone ahead but I caught up with him {T}.

The Quran has used ”تَبِعَ“ (*tabeh*) against ”عَصَى“ (*asi*) or mutiny in 14:36. As such, ”اِتَّبَاعُ“ (*ittebah*): loyalty towards Allah's laws. It means to follow His laws. Against this is the person who reverts.

3:134	And whoever turns on his heels	وَمَنْ يَنْقَلِبْ عَلَى عَقْبَيْهِ
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Deen is a collective system, therefore the laws of Allah will not be obeyed individually or selectively, but obeisance will be subject to the whole system. This system was first formulated by, our Messenger, and therefore the obedience to Allah's laws was through obedience to him, as stated in 7:157. After him, the system moved ahead, and the obedience of the Caliphs (the four Caliphs who came after him) took the same place. That is why the Quran has instructed not to revert to old ways after the death of Messenger, but continue obeying. See 3:143.

Note that ”اِتِّبَاعُ“ (*itbah*) and ”اطَاعَتُ“ (*ita'a*) have a minor difference, like to follow and to obey. Definitely ”اطَاعَتُ“ (*ita'a*) means following as well as obedience, which is done for the sake of the mentor, but it does have a connotation of an order or moral requirement. ”اِتِّبَاعُ“ (*itbah*), on the other hand, is following at one's own will due to love, or attraction, but not due to some order or requirement.

”اَلتَّابِعُ“ (*at-tabeh*) or ”اَلتَّبِيعُ“ (*at-tabeeh*): a servant {T}. The plural of ”تَابِعٌ“ (*tabeh*) is ”اَلتَّابِعِينَ“ (*at-tab'een*) as used in 24:31. However, the meaning of ”تَبِيعًا“ (*tabeeaa*) in 17:69 is of prosecutor in a case, or one who questions, somebody who demands your answers (for payment of your debt).

Surah *Ash-shura* uses the word ”اِتِّبَاعُ“ (*ittebah*), which means to bring out a procession. In other words, to put the victorious sorcerers in front, and take them in a procession, as in 26:40.

”تَبَعَ“ (*Taba'*): to talk about a second thing in relation to the first. For incidents to occur continuously, one after another {T}. ”اَلتَّبَعُ“ (*at-tooba*) was the title of the kings of Yemen, because they ascended the throne in a continuous line {T}.

The Quran mentions the nation of **Tubbah** in 50:14. This has been detailed in a separate heading. See heading **Tubbah**.

The *Kitab-il-Ashqaaq* mentions the meaning of ”اَلتَّبَعُ“ (*at-tubba*) as shade, perhaps because a shade moves along with the relative source of light.

Surah *Qaf* says:

50:14	The fellowship of <i>al-ayka</i> and the nation of <i>Tubb'a</i> , all denied our Messengers.	وَأَصْحَابُ الْأَيْكَةِ وَقَوْمِ تُبَّعٍ كُلٌّ كَذَّبَ الرُّسُلَ
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At another place it is said with reference to the *Quresh* tribe:

44:37	Are they any better than the nation of <i>Tubb'a</i> ?	أَهْمُ خَيْرٌ أَمْ قَوْمِ تُبَّعٍ
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In *Suleman*'s tale, it is said that in eastern *Yemen*, the nation of *Saba* ruled. One branch of this nation, the *Himyar* was settled in western Yemen. When the Romans destroyed the economy of *Saba*, the economy of *Himyar* started to boom, and they became a wealthy and powerful nation. At first the people there were star worshippers, like the people of *Saba*, but later they became Jews. One of the kings of this dynasty adopted the title of *Tubb'a*, which means Sultan.

When during the time of king *Zunawas*, Christians started preaching Christianity, he became very angry. He attacked the centre of Christianity, which was *Najraan*. The citizens of this city resisted at first but succumbed later. *Zunawas*'s bias reached its peak and turned to barbarism. Anyone who refused to accept Judaism was thrown into big pits of fire.

This army of *Zunawas* has been mentioned in the Quran (85:4-9) as "أَصْحَابُ الْأُخْدُودِ" (*ashabul ukhood*), or the people of *Ukhlood*, and condemned this oppression by them. This is because the purpose of the Quran is to stop oppression, regardless who perpetrates it against whom.

T-J-R

ت ج ر

"تِجَارَةٌ" (*tijarah*): professional trade which includes buying and selling.

Raghib says "تِجَارَةٌ" (*tijarah*): to employ the principal (amount) for making a profit.

Muheet says the word also means the goods which are traded.

"تَاجِرٌ" (*tajir*) is a professional buyer and seller. The Arabs also used to call one who sold wine as "تَاجِرٌ" (*tajir*). Figuratively, "تِجَارَةٌ" (*tijarah*) is also cleverness or expertise (in something), and an expert is a "تَاجِرٌ" (*tajir*) {M}.

The Quran says:

2:16	their buying and selling made them no profit	فَمَا رَبَّحَتْ تِجَارَتُهُمْ
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This means that their adoption of the wrong path as against the right one brought them no gain.

The Quran has equated *Imaan* (Islam) with "تِجَارَةٌ" (*tijarah*), or a sort of trading in which a sort of buying and selling takes place.

Surah *At-Tauba* says:

9:111	verily Allah has bought the lives and possessions of the <i>momineens</i> and endowed them with <i>janna</i> in return:	إِنَّ اللَّهَ اشْتَرَى مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَنْفُسَهُمْ وَأَمْوَالَهُمْ بِأَنْ هُمْ الْجَنَّةَ
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In this trading, the *momineen* hand over their lives and possessions for a society that observes Allah's laws, and in turn that society provides them with a life fit for paradise in this world (and they get *janna* in the life of Hereafter as well)

This is the sort of trading about which it is mentioned in another verse:

61:10-11	O group of momineen ! Would you like me to tell you about a trade which will deliver you from a painful punishment? That trade is for you to have faith in Allah and his Rusool. And struggle in the way of Allah with your lives and possessions. If you employ knowledge and insight, you will know how beneficial this trade is for you. The benefits of this trade are more beneficial than ordinary trade	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا هَلْ أَدُلُّكُمْ عَلَىٰ تِجَارَةٍ تُنْجِيكُمْ مِّنْ عَذَابٍ أَلِيمٍ تَأْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ وَتُجَاهِدُونَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ بِأَمْوَالِكُمْ وَأَنفُسِكُمْ ذَٰلِكُمْ خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ إِن كُنتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ
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Also see 26:11

As to how much profit can be taken from buying and selling, is mentioned under the heading (B-Y-Ain). The principle being that only remuneration for labor can be taken. No profit can be received on capital. This will apply to barter as well as trade. With this principle in mind, the following verse's meaning can be understood:

4:29	Don't gobble up on each other's wealth in a wrong way, excepting in trade with mutual agreement	لَا تَأْكُلُوا أَمْوَالَكُم بَيْنَكُم بِالْبَاطِلِ إِلَّا أَنْ تَكُونَ تِجَارَةً عَنْ تَرَاضٍ مِّنْكُمْ
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These days mutual agreement is taken to mean to demand as much profit as you would like from the customer and ask him to buy a thing if he can afford it. Then, if he still buys, it means that he is ready to pay as much profit as demanded. This is self-deception. The customer is forced by his need to pay the shopkeeper's demanded price. For the difference between barter (*bai*) and trade (*tijarah*) see heading (B-Y-Ain). The above mentioned situation cannot be called "تِجَارَةٌ عَنْ تَرَاضٍ مِّنْكُمْ" (*tijaratan un tarazin minkum*). If the profit is return of one's labor only, and is fixed by the society, then every customer will gladly pay it. That will be a mutual willingness.

The Quran says:

4:29	don't degrade each other	وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ
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This means to not degrade one's own people. To benefit from another's need is like killing or degrading your own people. To demand just the compensation for labor is a practice described as:

2:279	neither are you oppressed nor are you the oppressor	لَا تَظْلِمُونَ وَلَا تُظْلَمُونَ
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Trading in a society should be to fulfill each other's needs, not to annihilate others. If trade stands in the way of Quranic unchangeable values, then destruction will follow as the result of it. 9:24.

T-H-T ت ح ت

"تَحْتَ" (*tahat*) is the opposite of "فَوْقُ" (*fauq*) which means over/above. So the meaning of this word is "below"

2:25	below which streams are flowing	تَجْرِي مِنْ تَحْتِهَا الْأَنْهَارُ
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"التَّحَوُّتُ" (*at-tahut*) is the plural of "تَحْتَ" (*tahat*) and means people of the lower strata.

Raghib says that "تَحْتَ" (*tahat*) doesn't mean the underside of a thing, but something which is below that thing. In this context "أَسْفَلُ" (*asfal*) shall be the underside of that thing. This means that when something is below another thing it is "تَحْتَ" (*tahat*), but the underside of that thing is "أَسْفَلُ" (*asfal*).

“الْأَرْضُ” (*at-tarb*) or “الْأُتْرَابُ” (*at-turab*): the soil, ground, earth, dirt. As the words “عَلَيْهِ تَرَابٌ” (*alaihi turab*) has been used in 2:264. The plural form is “أُتْرَابٌ” (*aribah*) as well as “تُرْبَانٌ” (*tirbaan*)

“مُتْرَبَةٌ” (*matrabah*): poverty, or starvation.

“ذَامُتْرَبَةٌ” (*za matrabah*): to be covered with dust, needy, in misery as used in 90:16 {T}.

“جَمَلٌ تَرْبُوتٌ” (*jamalan taraboot*): obedient as a pet or trained camel {T}

“الْأُتْرَابُ” (*at-traaib*) has been translated to ribs in 86:6.

“الْأُتْرَابُ” (*at-tirb*): being of the same age. Plural is “أُتْرَابٌ” (*at-traab*).

Ibn Turab says it means of being the same age and contemporary, and those are its basic meanings. It also means friend, beloved and companion.

Describing the *Jannah*, the Quran mention words like “عُرُبًا أَتْرَابًا” (*ooroban at raban*) in 56:37 and “كَوَاعِبُ أَتْرَابًا” (*kwaiba atraba*) in 78:33. These words are generally translated as wives of the same age, but it means companions which are homogenous in habits and hobbies which are cut from the same fabric.

“أُتْرَابًا” (*at-raaba*) is the adjective of “كَوَاعِبُ” (*kwaib*) and “عُرُبًا” (*oroban*), thus it would mean such women who are of the same bent of mind. In other words, there will be no emotions of envy, or strangeness between them but agreement of thought etc. It can also mean mutual agreement between husband and wife. Hence the meaning is of such women who would have similar opinions and thoughts as their husbands. What sort of relationship it would be between them in the hereafter is beyond our comprehension, but in this world we all know how a household can be turned into a blissful heaven if husband and wife are in agreement. See 2:231. But since “أُتْرَابٌ” (*atraab*) also means similar people and contemporaries, that is why there is an element of egalitarianism and equality in it as well. See heading (Z-W-J).

“الْأُتْرَفَةُ” (*at-turfah*): the bliss of being plentiful, in abundance, delightful meal, a good thing {T}.

“تُرِفٌ” (*taarif*): he became bountiful and happy. He got the luxuries of life.

“أُتْرِفٌ” (*at-ruff*): made him happy.

“الْمُتْرَفُ” (*al-mutraf*): he who is living a life of luxury and is pursuing the road to pleasure and temptations, someone who is drunk with happiness and plentiful. Some think that it means a rich man, who with his wealth becomes a leader, and whatever he does is not challenged. It can also be used for a man who does what he pleases, and there is nobody to admonish him {T}, or he who due to excess of wealth, becomes mutinous.

The plural is “مُتْرَفُونَ” (*mutrafoon*) and “مُتْرَفِينَ” (*mutrafeen*).

“أُتْرَفٌ فَلَانٌ” (*atraf falan*): he became mutinous and kept on disobeying.

“مُتْرَفِينَ” (*mutrafeen*) is an important term in the Quran. The Quran has said it is usual that whenever someone from Allah called people to the right path, then the “مُتْرَفِينَ” (*mutrafeen*) of the nation strongly opposed him. These are the people who thrive on others' labor and rule them as well. It is obvious that such people have no place in Allah's system. That is why they always oppose this system.

The Quran says:

34:33	We have never sent anyone to warn a society, where the <i>mutrafeen</i> did not say that “we oppose this message that you have brought”	وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا فِي قَرْيَةٍ مِّن نَّذِيرٍ إِلَّا قَالَ مُتْرَفُوهَا إِنَّا بِمَا أُرْسِلْتُمْ بِهِ كَافِرُونَ
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The following verse explains who these *mutrafeen* are:

34:34	They used to say “we have abundance of wealth and progeny, so who can touch us?”	وَقَالُوا نَحْنُ أَكْثَرُ أَمْوَالًا وَأَوْلَادًا
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This is the same group which these days are called the capitalist group, and which acquires power on the basis of its wealth. This includes the religious leaders who do not do any work themselves but thrive on the earnings of others and rule the very same people. The Quran says that this group too is in the forefront of opposition to Allah’s system and instigates people by saying that “see this revolutionary (*Rusool*), he opposes the religion that your forefathers maintained” 34:43, 43:23. These are all *mutrafeen* and Quran has called them mankind’s worst enemies.

T-R-K

ت ر ك

“تَرَكَ” (*tarkun*) is to let go, to throw, also to insert, to empty.

“تَرَكَهَ الرَّجُلُ” (*terakut ul rijuli*) is the assets a person leaves behind after death.

“تَرِيكُهُ” (*tareekatunh*) is a woman whom nobody marries. It also means an egg-shell, from which the chick has hatched out {T}.

“التَّرِيكُ” (*al-tareeku*) is a bunch which has been stripped of all its fruit or eaten up {T}.

Some maintain it to mean abandoning a job, regardless if it is done intentionally or unwillingly. It includes both scenarios. Hence it means to abandon a job one was conducting, or to become careful from doing it. To avoid it, is “تَرَكَ” (*tarka*) as well. Hence Ibn Faris says that a garden where its keeper does not pay attention to it, and avoid its maintenance, is called “التَّرِيكُ” (*at-tareek*). But the work that is abandoned because of one’s weakness of not being able to do it cannot be called “تَرَكَ” (*tarkun*) according to *Muheet*.

“تَرَكَ” (*taraka*) is also used instead of “جَعَلَ” (*ja’la*). This means “to give it a shape”.

“تَارَكَهُ” (*taarakahu*) is to keep the matter in the state that it was in before {T, L}.

It also means to give a matter a state of permanence, for example as given in the following verse:

37:78	We have kept the discussion open for the next generation	وَتَرَكْنَاهُ عَلَيْهِ فِي الْآخِرِينَ
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This means that it has been given continuity.

T-S-Ain

ت س ع

“تِسْعَةُ رَجَالٍ” (*tisatun rijaalin*): nine men.

“تِسْعُ نِسْوَةٍ” (*tisu’ niswatin*): nine women.

“تِسْعُ آيَاتٍ” (*tisu’ aayaatin*): nine signs (27:12).

“تِسْعَةَ عَشَرَ” (*tisa’tah a’shara*): nineteen (overseers) (74-30).

“تِسْعٌ وَتِسْعُونَ نَعْجَةً” (*tis’u wa ts’ona ja’jah*): “ninety nine sheep” (38:23).

Ibn Faris has stated its fundamental meaning to be “to turn”.

“النَّعْسُ” (*at-ta’su*): to fall flat on one’s face and be incapable of getting up. It also means to stagger, death, to be degraded and deterioration.

“تَعَسَّهٖ اللّٰهُ” (*ta a’saullah*): Allah destroyed them.

“فَهُوَ مَتْعُوسٌ” (*fahuwa matu’sun*): hence he was destroyed.

“تَعَسَّالَهُ” (*ta’saan lahu*): to curse someone {T}.

The Quran says:

47:8	the people who opted to reject and to rebel, for them there is death and destruction, disgrace and adversity	وَالَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا فَتَعَسَّأْ لَهُمْ
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“الْتَفَثُ” (*al-tafthu*) *Taj-Ul-Uroos*, has stated with reference to other dictionaries, that this word does not appear in the poetry of the pre-Islamic era. Hence its literal meaning cannot be given. In commentaries though, “تَفَثٌ” (*tafathun*) is given as, ‘shaving of one’s head’, ‘rami (casting stones)’ and ‘animal sacrifice’ rituals of the *Hajj* {T, R}.

Muheet said that “الْتَفَثُ” (*al-tafthu*) does not only mean disheveling, but also confusion and anxiety.

Ibn Abbas said that “تَفَثٌ” (*tafathun*) stands for all the rituals of *Hajj*. He includes the cutting or shaving off the hair, trimming the moustache or the hair of the armpit in the meaning of this word.

Thus Quran says:

22:29	then it is required that they should complete their <i>tafath</i>	ثُمَّ لِيَقْضُوا تَفَثَهُمْ
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“تَفَثَ لِرَجُلٍ يَتَفَثُ” (*tafitha al rijaalu yutfathu*) is when a person stops grooming his hair, thus the hair become dishevelled and disturbed {M}. As given above, the Quran states in verse 22:29 “then it is required that they should complete their *tafath*”. If this is limited to the activities of Hajj, then it would mean the grooming of hair only. But if the metaphoric meanings are taken, then it would mean to consider the ways to remove the traumas and troubles of the whole community.

The *Hajj* is the universal gathering to consider the solution of removing traumas and troubles of the community. See heading (H-L-Q) for the details of shaving head during Hajj.

“الْتِقْنُ” (*al-tiqnu*) is a skilled person {T, M}. It means all the expertise necessary to establish an economic system; the thing that helps to solve an issue; an example is of the expertise in mineralogy; anything that may help in correcting something {T}.

Ibn Faris gives these fundamental meanings:

- To strengthen some thing
- Sticky black soil.

“أَتَقَّنَ الْأَمْرَ اتِّقَانًا” (*at-taqan al amra itqaa nan*): To firmly establish an issue {T, M}.

The Quran states in relation to Allah:

27:88	He has created everything absolutely proper and firmly	أَتَقَّنَ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ
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In Quran, wherein by describing the attributes of God, the true concept of His is revealed. At the same time it establishes the fact that individuals, nations, society or a system that follows Allah's laws, will develop the same attributes within the limits of its humanness.

For example:

27:88	It is Allah's attribute that He has created everything perfect	صُنِعَ اللّٰهُ الَّذِي اَتَمَّنْ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ
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It is to show that everything the community of believers produces will be as near perfect. It will have neither slack nor wrinkles in it, and it will not be weak or incomplete. In the scheme of nature it is vehemently asserted, as is in verse 67:3

67:3	you will not find lack of proper proportion in the creation of Rahman, the most merciful	كَهَ مَا تَرَىٰ فِي خَلْقِ الرَّحْمٰنِ مِن تَفَٰوُتٍ
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Similarly one will have the assurance of perfection and balance in things established by the believers.

Hence, it can be deduced from this as to how much the above group would be the cause of peaceful and satisfactory coexistence for humanity. This is just one of the aspects of Allah's attributes. Imagine the condition of a nation that possesses such attributes of Allah!

Tilka تِلْكَ

“تِلْكَ” (*tilka*) is used for something distant, ‘that’. It is a feminine form. For details see heading “ذَا” (*zaa*).

T-L-L ت ل ل

The fundamental meaning of “تَلَّ” (*tallu*) is the land that is considerably higher than the surroundings. “التَّلُّ مِنَ التُّرَابِ” (*al-latlu min turaab*) is a mound of dirt.

“التَّلُّ” (*at-tallo*): a pillow or mattress. It also means to spread or to put down on the mound. It may be from “تَلِيلٌ” (*talilun*) which means the neck and cheeks. Hence it would mean, to drop someone on the neck and the face.

“تَلَّهٗ” (*tallahu*), “يَتَلَّهٗ” (*yatilluhu*) and “تَلَّ” (*tallan*): that he has thrown someone down.

“قَوْمٌ تَلَّى” (*qoum-un talla*) is a nation that has been thrown down.

“تَلَّ” (*tallu*), “يَتَلَّى” (*yatllu*) is to be thrown down, to fall down, to fall.

“التَّلَّ” (*at-tallatuh*) is to fall, to put down (once).

“الْمِثْلُ” (*al-mitalu*) is the place for the above; or the spear with which someone is put down.

“الَّتْلَى” (*allutla*) is the slaughtered goat {*T, M, R*}

In Quran is given:

37:108	he put him down on his side (on his temple)	وَتَلَّهٗ لِلْجَبِينِ
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“تَلَوْتُهُ” (*talutuhu*), “تَتْلِيْنُهُ” (*talaituhu*): that I followed him.
 “أَتَتْلِيْنُهُ إِيَّاهُ” (*atlaituhu iyyaahu*): that I made him follow in his footsteps.
 “تَلُو” (*taloowan*) is the person who always follows.
 “الْأَتْلُو” (*attiloo*) is a thing that follows another, for example, the young animal that follows its mother.
 “أَتَلَّتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*atlati an naaqatih*) is the baby camel that follows its mother.
 “الْأَتَالِي وَ الْآتَالِي” (*at-tawaalee wat taaliyaatu*): the back parts.
 “الْأَتْلِيَّة” (*at-taleeyatuh*) and “الْأَتْلَوَّة” (*at-tulaawatuh*) is the remaining unpaid portion of a debt.

Raghib states that “تَلَاوَة” (*tilaawatunh*): to follow in the footsteps or to obey. This could be in a physical sense or in the sense of obedience to somebody.

“تَلَا” (*tala*) means to follow somebody in a way that nobody else comes in between. This sometimes occurs physically and sometimes means to follow in spirit. In this meaning the root of the word is “تَلَو” (*tuluwwun*) or “تَلَو” (*watilwu*). When it means to read or deliberate then its root is “تِلَاوَة” (*tilawah*).

The example of following physically is of the Moon:

61:2	the moon follows the Sun and benefits from its light	وَالْقَمَرَ إِذَا تَلَاهَا
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“تَلَّاهُ تَتْلِيَا” (*talaalahu tatallian*): he followed behind him.
 “تَتْلِيْتُ حَقِّي” (*tatalliyatu haqqyi*): I followed him and extracted my full dues from him {T, M}

For the obedience of divine laws, it is mandated to ‘study’ the Quran. According to **Raghib**, “تَلَاوَة” (*tilaawa*) is especially meant for the obedience of Divine Scriptures. In order to obey these laws, it is essential firstly to understand the given instructions in them. Hence this too is termed as “تَلَاوَة” (*tilaawa*), but it is a particularized form of “قَرَأَة” (*qiraa a*) (to read). However “قَرَأَة” (*qiraa*) is inclusive of “تَلَاوَة” (*tilaawa*) (to obey, but not the other way round). Therefore, “تَلَاوَة” (*tilawa*) as reading of the Quran, means to study it in order to follow its instructions (not merely to recite it).

“تَلَاَهُ” (*talaahu*) also means “he has been set free”, in a way that he then follows behind (**Ibn Faris**).

In The Quran is given:

2:121	Those who have been given this book, they read (<i>tilaawath</i>) it in a honest way, and these are the people who have trust in the book	الَّذِينَ آتَيْنَاهُمُ الْكِتَابَ يَتْلُونَهُ حَقَّ تِلَاوَتِهِ أُولَئِكَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِهِ
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Therefore, obviously it can only mean to obey the book, because it has been said that ‘these people have trust in the book’. If it had meant as merely to recite, then even non-believers read Quran. Hence Quran’s *tilaawa* is to obey it’s given instructions. It is read, so that it can be understood and it can then be obeyed. Otherwise it would be a futile exercise just to recite it. The Quran said that a **Momin** is one who follows it implicitly.

In Quran, it is given with reference to the Messenger:

3:163	he presents Allah’s laws to the community	يَتْلُو عَلَيْهِمْ آيَاتِهِ
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It says that he simultaneously provided the resources, for the development of their potentials. See heading (**Z-K-W**).

It is apparent then, when it is asked to read the Quran, that Allah’s system of laws should be demonstrably implemented so that it’s tangible and constructive outcomes are obvious. Therefore it is self-deception to think that just by reciting the Quran, its purpose is fulfilled. Hence it is imperative to read and understand and then to act on its teaching. Otherwise just reciting it is futile.

The Quran says in surah **As-Saffah**:

37:3	the community that obeys the Quran	قَالَتِ الْيَتَامَىٰ ذِكْرًا
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In surah *Al-Baqarah*, of the charge against the Jews is that:

2:102	These people follow the <i>Shaitan</i> (the enemy of Allah's way) who has spread falsehood against the kingdom of Solomon	وَاتَّبَعُوا مَا تَتْلُوا الشَّيَاطِينُ عَلَىٰ مُلْكِ سُلَيْمَانَ
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If one wishes to know, what false tales have been spread by the enemies of *bani Israil's* divine Messengers, and how the Jews have propagated these tales as divine revelations, then one should read the Old Testament of the Bible. Therein are such falsehoods against these Messengers that any self-respecting person would not like to know.

T-M-M ت م م

”تَمَامُ الشَّيْءِ“ (*tamamush-shaiyi*): something that adds to the completion of a thing.

Ibn Faris gives its fundamental meaning as ‘complete’.

Some maintain that ”تَمَامُ“ (*tamaamun*) and ”كَمَالُ“ (*kamaalun*) are synonymous, but others maintain that ”تَمَامُ“ (*tamaamun*) is to contribute towards the completion of a thing and ”كَمَالُ“ (*kamaalun*) is the finite limit to which a thing has developed, or to accomplish the purpose for which a thing was made. For example ”رَجُلٌ تَامُ الْخُلُقِ“ (*rajulun taamul khalqi*) means “such a man who has no constitutional defects”.

”كَامِلُ الْخُلُقِ“ (*kaamilun khalqi*): something that has attained the maximum perfection and beauty.

So, it goes a step further than ”تَمَامُ“ (*tamaamun*) {T}.

”تَمَّ الشَّيْءُ“ (*tamma al shaiyi*): the thing is complete.

”تَمَّ عَلَيْهِ“ (*tamma alaihi*): the person remained steadfast.

”أَتَمَّ الشَّيْءُ“ (*at tammash-shaiyi*): he completed the thing {T}.

It is given in Quran:

2:124	When the Creator gave the resources for Ibrahim to develop himself, he with his steadfastness and persistence, achieved it to its fullest extent and proved that he had no shortcomings left in him what so ever	وَإِذِ ابْتَلَىٰ إِبْرَاهِيمَ رَبُّهُ بِكَلِمَاتٍ فَأَتَمَّهُنَّ
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In Surah *Al-Maidah* is given:

5:3	Now We have established your authority and control to its fullest extent, that is to say that there was no rebellious power left to oppose you and your life system was fully developed, and whatever shortcomings were there, We removed them	الْيَوْمَ أَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ وَأَتَمَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ نِعْمَتِي
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This means that the opponents who were at loggerheads with the Messenger for years have been made to surrender. Though *Deen* (the system of Allah) had made progress even after the Messenger's death. If *Deen* is taken to mean the way of Islam, then the meaning could be the completion of the *deen* which reached its zenith in the Quran.

In Surah *Al-Ana'm* it is given:

6:116	Whatever was left to be implemented of Allah's laws, was done with truth and balance and so there is none to make any changes in it	وَتَمَّتْ كَلِمَتُ رَبِّكَ صِدْقًا وَعَدْلًا لَا مُبَدِّلَ لِكَلِمَتِهِ
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Thus the Code (*ad-Deen*) was completed so there is no need to add to the divine laws or make any change, then there is no reason for a new messenger to come.

”مُتِمُّ“ (*mutimmin*): “the one who completes a thing (61:8).

“التَّنَوَّرُ” (*at-tannawarun*), some say that its root is “نَارُ” (*naarun*). See (*N-W-R*). But some maintain that this word is Persian. The Arabs have Arabised it. One of its meanings is the same as in Urdu, which is of the oven (*tandoor*) for baking bread. But “التَّنَوَّرُ” (*tannuwaru*) is also the pond where water collects in a valley, and hence, all such places from where water springs. It also means a raised and high ground {*T, M, Lataif-ul-Lugha*}.

The Quran mentions this word with reference to Noah’s flood. It has been used in 11:40 to define the place in the valley where the water collected. That is to say, it rained so heavily that the rainwater formed a flood.

T-W-B

ت و ب

“تَابَ” (*taaba*), “تَوَّابًا” (*tawban*), “تَوْبَةً” (*towbatan*), “مَتَابًا” (*mataaban*): all these words include the sense of returning {*T*}. An example is as if you are walking on the path (of life) and come to a crossroad, so you take a turn. After some distance you realize that you have taken a wrong turn, so to get back on the right path you have to return to the crossroad where you went wrong. This action of turning back is called “تَوْبَةً” (*towbah*).

It is obvious that you have to walk back to the spot from where you made the error. If you stand there all your life lamenting as to why you took the wrong turn, it would not be “تَوْبَةً” (*towbah*). Hence “تَوْبَةً” (*towbah*) is the action one takes to ‘undo’ the wrong that one did in the first place. This then corrects the ill effects of the error.

“تَابَ عَنْهُ” (*taaba a’nhu*) and “مَنْهُ” (*minhu*): that, one has realized one’s error and stopped following on the wrong path and then started on the right path. “تَوْبَةً” (*towbah*) comprises of the three elements, firstly the realization of one’s error, secondly to stop continuing with the error and turn back and finally to follow the right way. Such a person is called “تَائِبٌ” (*taaibun*) {*T*}.

Therefore Quran says:

11:114	righteous actions have the reaction to eliminate the ill effects	إِنَّ الْحَسَنَاتِ يُذْهِبْنَ السَّيِّئَاتِ
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This is “تَوْبَةً” (*towbah*). It is important to understand a particular point here. If one robs other’s right, but after sometime realizes the error and repents, then the right thing to do is to restore the person’s right and make a vow that one will not rob other’s right again.

The second example is, if you have some liquor, and after some time you realize that in Islam it is forbidden, the “تَوْبَةً” (*tauba*) in this case would be for you to repent and never ever touch liquor again.

In the first related example, when you took the wrong turn, the right path had left you when you realized your mistake and reverted to the right path. The right path too, which had turned away from you, (as it were) was available again. Moreover, when you took one step toward it, it took two steps toward you. Two because one was the wrong step which you retracted and the second was the step you took towards it. This is known as “تَابَ عَلَيْهِ” (*taaba alaih*), and one who does this is called “تَوَّابٌ” (*tawwab*).

The Quran says the following with regards to Allah:

110:3	He is returning	إِنَّهُ كَانَ تَوَّابًا
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While the following words are regarding the people:

2:222	Indeed Allah prefer those who do <i>tauba</i>	إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ التَّوَّابِينَ
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This means when man turns away from non-divine systems and adopts the laws of Allah, then this system with all its happy results turn toward man.

That is why in 3:127 this word is used against “عَذَابٌ” (*azaab*). Also in 9:106 its meaning is that if a man sins or commits a crime then he is not distanced from life's happiness forever. Whenever he reverts to Allah's laws, they will jump towards him. That is, everyone has a chance to retract. That is why every nation has a chance for renaissance.

In a nation's life, this moment comes when life anew becomes impossible. See heading (*H-L-K*). This is however possible only if there is a chance that man will do good deeds. When the time to act ends, so does the time to retract. Retraction is not possible in state of *Jahannum*.

To understand the difference between “توبه” (*tauba*) and “استغفار” (*isteghaar*), see heading (*Gh-F-R*).

Lataiful Lughah says “توبه” (*tauba*) is repentance at previous faults, while “استغفار” (*isteghaar*) is shunning future sins.

“التَّابُوتُ” (*at-taboot*): box, or trunk, because the things taken out of it are also put back {*T*}. In this sense also see heading (*Taboot*).

T-W-R ت و ر

“التَّوْرُ” (*taur*): to flow, to be issued, envoy, be ambassador.

“التَّوْرَةُ” (*at-taurah*) is a slave girl who keeps on coming and going (flitting in and out) among her lovers.

“التَّارَةُ” (*at-tarah*): time, status.

“جِئْتُهُ تَارَةً أُخْرَى” (*je'tohu taratun ukhra*): I went to him twice.

“أَتَارَهُ” (*ataarah*): he defeated him repeatedly.

“التَّائِرُ” (*at-taa-iro*): tired but still engaged in work {*T*}.

Surah *Taaha* says:

20:55	we will raise you for a second time	نُخْرِجُكُمْ تَارَةً أُخْرَى
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Raghib says this is with reference to “تَارَ الْجُرْحُ” (*Taral jurah*) which means for a wound to heal. It means to flow, continue, and to be engaged in work despite being tired. Considering these meanings, imagine how meaningful this word “تَارَةً” (*taratan*) is for us. Life is continuous, only conditions keep changing. This is what “تَارَةً أُخْرَى” (*taratan ukhra*) is.

Taurah التَّوْرَةُ

Some say that this word has been derived from “وَرَى” (*wari*) which means to light up {*T*}. See heading (*W-R-Y*).

But the correct view word is the same as *Muheet* has explained. *Muheet* says that this is the Arabised form of the Hebrew word, meaning way of life (*shariat*) and orders. The plural is “تَوْرَاتٌ” (*taurat*) i.e. orders and ways.

It is generally thought that *Taurah* is the name of the book which was revealed to *Mosa*, but the Quran does not say specifically that *Moosa's* book was named *Taurah*. About *Taurah* it has said that it was revealed after Ibrahim (3:64) and after *Yaqoob* (3:92), but before *Isa* (Jesus) (5:46).

It was celestial guidance for the Jews and contained Allah's laws (5:43). The scholars of the Jews used to adjudicate on its basis (5:44). This makes it clear that *Taurah* is the collection of books that were revealed to the Messengers of *Bani Israel* and were revealed before *Isa*. This collection is what they call the Old Testament which consists of thirty nine documents, and each document is named with reference to its Messenger. *Isfaarey Musa* (Books of Moses) are included in them

The Quran calls them '**Suhafey Musa**' or **Moses' books** (87:19), and also '**Kitaabey Musa** (46:14). According to the practice at that time, these books were written on tablets (7:145).

The New Testament contains thirty nine books but some other books have been referred to which are not in this collection. At least eleven such books can be counted. This shows that the collection is not complete.

“**Asfaarey Musa**” is linked to **Musa** (Moses) but it contains matters about his death and after. This means that at least some part of the book was added later.

Research has not yet determined as to when the New Testament was completed and who were the compilers. But this is known that at one time they had become extinct i.e. when in 6 B.C Babylon's king **Bakht Naser** (Nebuchadnezzar) destroyed Jerusalem (see heading Bani Israel). He had burnt the Torah to ashes. When the Jews returned again to **Baitul Muqaddus** (Temple of Solomon) they looked for their lost Book. As such **Azra Nabi** (Messenger Ezra) compiled the first five books as a historian but it is not known when **Azra Nabi** himself had come to Jerusalem. It is commonly believed that he compiled the books in 444 A.D.

As to how the compilation and editing etc. was done, **Azra's** own words are quoted:

“The second or next day a voice called me and said: Azra, open your mouth and drink what I give you to drink. So I opened my mouth. Then he sent me a goblet. It was filled with water but its color was fiery. I took it and drank. When I drank it, my chest became insightful and understanding and my soul made my memory strong. When I then spoke, I did not stop for forty days and the writers continued to write. They used to write the whole day and used to eat only at night. And I used to dictate to them the whole day. In 40 days they wrote down 204 books” (Book of **Azra** 2:14, 44:34:38)

This statement needs no explanation, but the only thing that can be added to it, is that Jerusalem was destroyed in 578 A.D. and **Azra** dictated these books in 444 A.D, which is about one hundred and fifty years later. Obviously **Azra** had not seen these books and had memorized them from somewhere. That is why he didn't have the memorized books rewritten, but dictated new books. Then also, according to **Azra** himself, he had dictated 204 books but now it is believed that he dictated only five books (which are called **Isfarey Musa**).

After **Azra**, **Nahmyiah Nabi** (Messenger Nehemiah) had some other books compiled, but in 168 B.C the Greek king of **Antakia**, **Antonious** again destroyed Jerusalem and destroyed their Holy Books. Then due to the courage and diligence of **Yahuda Maqabi**, they were compiled once again. But in 70 B.C. the Roman general Titus destroyed **Baitul Muqaddas** in such a way that the Jews could not settle there again. He took the Holy Books with him. Then the Jew scholars recompiled them from memory.

It was not only the celestial and earthly events destroyed those books. They were also deliberately tampered with. As such, the famous Christian historian, **Renan** writes in his book “Life of Jesus”:

“During the time near to Christ, many important changes were made in the Torah. Completely new books were compiled, and these were supposed to contain the real sharia (ways) of Moses, although they were different in spirit to the old books” (page 40).

Besides this, the Jews came up with another thought. They said that **wahi** (Revelation) was of two types. One was **Torah Shabaktub** (in book form) and the other **Torah Shibulfaa** (not in book form). The Jewish scholars also collected the traditions and gave it the respect of Torah. This collection is called **Mishna**.

Then the explanatory (exegetical) books (**tafseerat**) of this book were collected, which were called **Jamrah**. Both are called **Talmud**. There are two **Talmuds**: one is Syrian, the other is Babylonian. Both are considered to be celestial and both were compiled in the fifth century.

Besides this, the Jews also believe in “insightful knowledge”. The books on this are called “**safrim janosiyam**” (the books of hidden treasures).

Let us now turn to the Torah's language:

The ancient language of the Jews was **Hebrew**. Upon returning from Babylon their language turned to **Aramaic**, but none of their books was either in **Hebrew** or **Aramaic**. All their books the world knows about are in the Greek language. **Isfaarey Moosa** were translated from Greek to Hebrew. This Greek volume was in the library of Alexandria which the Romans burnt down in 394 A.D.

St. Jerome published the famous Roman translation of these works known as the Vulgate. It is not known which volume was translated by St. Jerome.

The copies of the Torah, which are currently circulated in the world, differ in that the first volume was printed in 1488, its second edition which was arranged in 1750 differed in about 12,000 points. This second edition is now considered as the Torah. (Old Testament).

To know about the differences of Jewish scholars and Christian researchers about the current Torah, see the first chapter i.e. **Zohrul Fisaad** of my book **Meraj Insaniyat**.

This is the brief description of the Torah which the Jews present as their celestial book and about which fourteen hundred years ago the Quran had said, had been badly mutilated by them.

When the Quran says one must believe in the former celestial books, it only means that one accepts that Messengers of yesteryears also used to receive Revelation. It is not demanded that you believe in the books which the Jews and the Christians (People of the Book) call celestial books today. As to how the Quran certifies these books, see **(S-D-Q)**.

T-Y-N

ت ي ن

“الَّتَيْنِ” (**at-teen**): fig, or the fig tree. It is also the name of a mountain, just like “زَيْتُونُ” (**Zaitoon**), which is also the name of a hill **{T, R}**.

“الَّتَيْنِ” (**at-teen**) is the place where Noah began his preaching (invitation). Similarly “زَيْتُونُ” (**Zaitoon**) is the place where Jesus began his preaching.

The Quran has used the names of these places (**teen, zaitoon, toor seena, and Mekkah**) as witnesses (95:1) to indicate that the struggle between good and bad is not something new, but has been continuing since time immemorial. Wherever the celestial message was delivered, the “مُتْرَفِينَ” **mutrafeen** opposed it. Whether the invitation was from **Noah** at (**at-teen**) or **Jesus** at (**zaitoon**), or **Moses** at (**at-toor**), or **Muhammed** at (**al-baladul amen**, meaning **Mecca**), all were opposed in the same way.

“أَرْضٌ تَيْهٌ” (*arzun teah*): the land where there are no dunes, nor mountains, no landmarks. Hence a traveller gets lost and worried

“تَاهَ يَتِيهُ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*ta’ah yateeho fil ard*): lose the way and roam around worried and harried:

“رَجُلٌ تَاهٍ” (*rojulun taayiah*): a wandering traveller {T}. This has led to “تَاهَ” (*ta’a’aha*), or “يَتِيهُ” (*yateehu*) which means to be surprised. These are its basic meanings, according to *Ibn Faris*.

“تَاهَ يَتِيهُ” (*ta’aha yateeho*): to pride oneself {T}.

“التَّيْهُ” (*at-tiyahu*), “الْتَّوْهُ” (*at-tauhu*): point of surprise {R}.

About the Bani Israel, it is said:

5:26	they will wander around (for forty years)	يَتِيهُونَ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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This condition is met by the nations that find ways to avoid Allah’s laws and which proffers different arguments about it. That nation wanders around in the journey of life and it doesn’t find a way out (like the Muslims of today).

Th-B-Th

ث ب ت

“ثَبَّتَ” (*thabath*): to be stable, to remain in one state.

“الْتَّبْتُ مِنَ الْخَيْلِ” (*thabot minal khail*) is a horse which keeps running at the same speed.

“الْتَّبَاتُ” (*al-sibat*) is the strap to which a camel is tied. The camel which is tied to this strap, is called

“الْمُتَّبْتُ” (*al-musbath*) {T}

Ibn Faris says it means the perpetuation of a thing.

In surah *Ar-Ra’ad*, “إِثْبَاتٌ” (*isbaath*) has appeared against “مَحْوٌ” (*mahwu*) which means to wipe out (13:39). Surah *Ibrahim* uses “يُسَبِّثُ” (*yusabbith*) against “يُضِلُّ” (*yazil*). Ergo, it means something that does not go waste and produces some result. Something which is not wiped out, but does not leave its place and stays stable.

“الْقَوْلُ الثَّابِتُ” (*al-qaulus sabith*) is used in 14:27 for a stable concept of life

“أَصْلُهَا ثَابِتٌ” (*asloha sabith*) is used in 14:24 for a tree with roots embedded strongly. Against it, there is a tree “أُجْنُتَتْ مِنْ فَوْقِ الْأَرْضِ مَالَهَا مِنْ قَرَارٍ” 14:26, which is uprooted easily and has no stability.

Surah *An-Nahal* uses “تُبْتُوتٌ” (*subuth*) against “تَزَلُّ” (*tazil*), meaning not to waver and staying put.

Surah *Bani Israel* uses it against “تَرْكُنُ” (*tarkana*) which is not to bend even a little, and not to lean at all. It is in 8:11 as “وَيُثَبِّتُ بِهِ الْأَقْدَامَ” (*wa subeta behil aqdaam*).

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:66	more strong in giving stability	وَأَشَدُّ ثَبَاتًا
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“دَاءُ ثَبَاتٍ” (*da-un sabat*) is a disease which leaves a man immobile {T, M, R}.

In this context, “أَثَبْتُ” (*asbat*): to imprison someone in a way as to make him immobile

Surah *Al-Infal* says “لِيُثَبِّتُوكَ” (*liyus betooka*) in 8:30, which also has the same meaning.

The characteristic of the group of Momineen is that t is adamant on the God given concept of life and acts according to it, so that it gains so much strength that it can be shaken by no other force from its place.

“الْتَبَرُ” (*as-sabar*): to stop (someone from something), or to prevent.

“مَاتَبَرَكَ عَنْ هَذَا” (*ma sabarak un haaza*): somewhere, something stopped him {T, M, R}

Ibn Faris says “الْتَبَرَةُ” (*sabarah*) is soil which is like lime.

“الْتَبَرُ” (*as-sabr*) is unrequited and unsuccessful, to be deprived of happiness.

As such “الْمُتَبَرُ” (*al-musabbar*) is a person who has been found guilty and has been sentenced, and thus is deprived of freedom {T}.

“الْمُتَبَرُ” (*al-musabbir*) is the place where camels are slaughtered. In this context “الْتَبُورُ” (*as-saboor*): annihilation and continuous destruction {T, M, R}.

25:13	they will call out to annihilation	دَعَوْا هُنَالِكَ تَبُورًا
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Here “الْتَبُورُ” (*masboor*): unsuccessful and unrequited, annihilated, idiotic, deprived {T, M, R}.

25:102	O Pharaoh, I notice that you lack intelligence	إِنِّي لَأَظُنُّكَ يَا فِرْعَوْنُ مَثْبُورًا
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“تَبَرَفُلَانٌ” (*sabar falanun*): a man was killed, or his development was curtailed. According to the Quran, both mean the same. See heading (J-H-M).

“تَبَطَّ عَنْ الْأَمْرِ” (*tabatah unil amrhe*): prevented (from doing something) and engaged in another work.

The Quran says:

9:46	so they were stopped	فَتَبَطَّاهُمْ
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“تَبَطَّ” (*tasbeet*): to stop someone from what he was doing. Some say it means to intervene between man and his intent

“الْتَبُّ” (*as-sabito*): someone who is lazy, incompetent and weak in his work. He who acts (moves) rather late {T, M}.

“الْتَبَّيَّةُ” (*at-tasbiah*) is used for the following:

- to collect a heap
- to be adamant at something and be consistent
- to praise one's tribe again and again
- to narrate the various high points
- to reform something and add to it
- to complete
- to respect.
- for a man to follow his father's traits
- to collect the good and the bad.
- to criticize and condemn a lot

“تَبَّيْتُ الْمَالَ” (*sabbaitul maal*): I deposited the wealth

“مَالٌ مُتَبَّى” (*maalun musabba*): the collected wealth

“الْتَبَّى” (*as-sabi-o*): he who praises people very much

“الْتَبَّةُ” (*as-soobah*): the central part of a small pool, a group of people, a group of horse riders

“جَاءَتِ الْخَيْلُ تُبَاتٍ” (*ja'atil khailo subat*): the horses came in batches.

Researchers say that it was actually “سَبَّحَ” (*sabwah*), but the “و” (*wa*) has been dropped.

Ibn Bari says that the researchers have used this saying, that the basic of this word is “سَبَّحَ” (*sabwah*).

Abu Ishaq says that it has been derived from “سَابَّابُ الْمَاءِ يَنْتُوبُ” (*sa’abal ma-oo yasub*).

Johri says that “سَبَّابُ” (*subat*) is the central part of the pool where water collects.

Raghib, however, says it’s root is “سَبَّيَ” (*sabyun*).

“سَبَّيَ الشَّيْءَ يَسْبِيهِ نَسْبِيًا” (*sabiush shaiya yasbeehi sabya*): to collect something, to make it bigger, correct it, to increase it, to complete it.

The Quran says:

54:71	you all come out as separate groups or all together	فَانْفِرُوا ثُبَاتٍ أَوْ تَنْفِرُوا جَمِيعًا
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Here “ثُبَاتٍ” (*subatin*) is the plural of “ثُبَّةٌ” (*subah*) which means a separate group or party.

As against it “جَمِيعًا” (*jameea*) has been used.

The plural is “ثُبَاتٍ” (*subatin*) and “ثُبُونٌ ثُبِينٌ” (*suboona subeen*), where the “ياء” (*ya*) has been omitted at the end {R}. See heading (Th-W-B).

Th-J-J

ث ج ج

“سَجَّ الْمَاءُ” (*sajjal ma-o*), “يَسُجُّ” (*yasujjo*), “سَجُوجًا” (*sajoojan*): the flow of water, to fall forcefully.

“انْسَجَّ” (*insajja*): the water fell.

“الْثَّجَّاجُ مِنَ الْمَطَرِ” (*as-sajjajo minal matar*): rain which is falling hard {T, M, F}.

The Quran says:

78:14	We brought down hard rain from the clouds	وَأَنزَلْنَا مِنَ الْمُعْصِرَاتِ مَاءً ثَّجَّاجًا
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Th-Kh-N

ث خ ن

“يَسْكُنُ” (*sakhun*), “يَسْكُنُ” (*yaskhun*): for something to become thicker or fatter, so that it cannot flow.

“أَسْكَنَ فِي الْعَدُوِّ” (*askhana fil uduway*): he killed and injured a lot of enemies.

“أَسْكَنَ مِنْهُ النَّوْمُ” (*istaskhana minhum naum*): sleep overwhelmed him.

“أَسْكَنَ” (*askhana*): he overpowered, he dominated {T}.

Surah *Al-Infal* says:

8:67	till he overpowers all the enemies (and prevents them from their opposition tactics)	حَتَّى يَغْلِبَ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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Surah *Al-Mohammed* says:

47:4	Until you overpower them.	حَتَّى إِذَا الْخَشْمُوهُمْ
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According to **Ibn Faris**, the basic meaning of “سَكَنَ” (*sakhan*) is to become so heavy, that it would restrict movement. Since the overpowered or killed cannot move from his place, this word is used in this manner. It would mean to overwhelm the enemy in such a way that it immobilizes him and surrenders due to being unable to oppose. As such “سَكْهِيْنٌ” (*sakhyeen*): a man who is without arms {F}.

Muheet says “سَكْهِيْنٌ” (*saheen*): to be unarmed. It is possible that the due to the basic meaning, both these meanings were created. This is perhaps because a man carrying a weapon has its burden to carry, and hence cannot move freely. In the same way, an unarmed person will also be scared from moving freely.

“ثَرْبٌ” (*sarb*): a thin layer of fat which is with the intestines.

“تَثْرِيبٌ” (*tasreeb*): to get rid of this fat, to remove it.

“تَرَبَّ الثَّوبُ” (*sarrabas sauba*): he rolled up the cloth.

“تَرَبَّهُ وَ عَلَيْهِ يُتَرَبُّ تَثْرِيبًا” (*sarrabahu a alaihi yusarribo tasreeba*): to condemn him for his mistake, to admonish him {*T, M, R*}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:9	There is no shame on you today. (I don't chide you, you are pardoned for past sins, and in future you will not be shamed.)	لَا تَنْفَرِبْ عَلَيْكُمُ الْيَوْمَ
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“يَثْرِبُ” (*yasrib*) is the ancient name for Medina {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

33:13	O dwellers of <i>Yasrib</i>	يَا أَهْلَ يَثْرِبَ
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“الْثَّرَى” (*asra*): moist, wet soil, soil which is moist but which has not turned into mud, the soil on top is dry but beneath it the earth is wet. This moist soil is called “ثَرَى” (*sara*).

20:6	whatever is beneath the <i>sara</i>	مَا تَحْتَ الثَّرَى
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“تَرَبَّتِ الْأَرْضُ” (*sariyatil arz*): that the earth became wet. Since this wetness of earth is necessary for agriculture, therefore “فُلَانٌ قَرِيبُ الثَّرَى” (*falanun qareebus sara*): a man who easily blesses others. Real wealth is attached to the wetness of the earth which is the fountainhead of wealth

“أَنَا ثَرَى بِهِ” (*ana sariun behi*): I am pleased with him.

“تَعَبَ الْمَاءُ” (*sa'abal ma'aa*): to make water flow.

“فَانْتَعَبَ” (*fa'ansa'ab*): the water flowed.

“مَاءٌ أَنْعَابٌ” (*ma'un usbaan*): water that flows.

“مَتَاعِبُ الْمَدِينَةِ” (*masa'ibun madinah*): the spots of the city from where the water flows.

“الْأَنْعَابُ” (*as-so'baan*): snake (long, thick, and male snake), since while moving a snake gives the appearance of a thin line of flowing water.

“الْأَنْعَابُ” (*al-usbaan*): a heavy, white and beautiful face {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are extension and to spread out.

In the tale about *Moosa* in the Quran, it is said:

7:107	then he put down his staff and it was clearly a snake	فَأَلْفَى عَصَاهُ فَإِذَا هِيَ ثُعْبَانٌ مُبِينٌ---
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For its figurative meaning, see heading (*Ain-Sd-W*).

“النَّقَبُ” (*as-saqbo*): a hole, an incision that goes through and through.
 “يَنْقُبُهُ” (*yasqubuh*), “نَقَبَهُ” (*saqabah*), “فَانْثَقَبَ” (*fansaqab*), a hole appeared in it.
 “الْمِنْقَبُ” (*almisqab*): the implement to drill a hole with.
 “نَقَبَتِ النَّارُ” (*saqabatin naar*): the fire (was) started.
 “نَقَبَ الْكَوْكَبُ” (*saqabul kaukab*): the shining star.
 “شِهَابٌ نَاقِبٌ” (*shihabun saqib*): a shooting star, as if it had drilled a hole in the blanket of darkness and come out, or its rays pierced the darkness of the atmosphere.
 “النَّقِيبُ” (*as-saqeeb*): a female camel who gives lots of milk, one whose lines of milk pierce {T}
 The Quran has said “شِهَابٌ نَاقِبٌ” (*shihabun saqib*) in 37:10 and “النَّجْمُ النَّاقِبُ” (*an najmus saqib*) in 86: 3.

“الْتَفَفُ” (*as-saqf*): expertise in sensing or getting at something or expertise in some work.
 “تَفَفْتُ كَذَا” (*saqifto kaza*): I got to the bottom of something with my expertise. Later this word started being used to mean getting something whether expertness of insight was included or not {R}. *Muheet's* compiler says it also means to acquire domination.

The Quran says:

60:2	if they dominate you, then they will become your enemy	إِنْ يَتَفَقَّهُكُمْ يَكُونُوا لَكُمْ أَعْدَاءُ
2:191	where you can sense (their ill intentions) dominate them	وَأَقْبَلُوهُمْ حَيْثُ تَفَقَّهُمُ هُمْ

“الْتِقَافُ” (*as-siqaaft*): infighting and to use swords. It also means the implement with which spears are straightened.
 “تَقَفَّتِ الْقَنَاةُ” (*saqqafatul qanat*): I straightened the bend in the spear. As such, “الْتِقَافَةُ” (*as-saqafah*): insight, intellect, and expertise. At the same time it also means to wield the sword and to straighten the spear {T, M, R}.

The first cultural craft of nations is the sword (defence capability), but in the end only poetry and story writing remains. A living nation's cultural crafts are insight and the swiftness of the blade.

“الْتَقْلُ” (*as-siqal*) is the opposite of “خَفَّةٌ” (*khiffah*), which means to be heavy and burdensome.

Raghib says that these words are opposites. When two things are compared with each other, the heavier is called “ثَقِيلٌ” (*saqeel*) and the lighter is “خَفِيفٌ” (*khafeef*). The plural of “ثَقِيلٌ” (*saqeel*) is “ثِقَالٌ” (*siqaal*).

“قَوْلًا ثَقِيلًا” (*qaulan saaqeela*): some talk of great importance (73:5).
 “ثَقَلَيْنِ” (*saqalain*): two great things, or groups.
 “أَيُّهُ الثَّقَلَانِ” (*ayyohas saqalaan*): Oh you, two classes (55:31)

Muheet's compiler says it means the *Arabs* and the *Ajams* (non-Arabic) as both are “ثَقْلٌ” (*saqal*) (great) on the earth.

“أَثْقَالٌ” (*asqaal*) is the plural of “ثِقْلٌ” (*siqal*) which means weight, load, the results of actions as used in (29:13).

Surah *Al-Zalzalah* says:

99:2	the earth will bring forth <i>asqaal</i> (whatever it has within) to the top	وَأَخْرَجَتِ الْأَرْضُ أَثْقَالَهَا
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The meaning in the above verse is of minerals etc. (the treasure buried in it) and the bigwigs too (who are buried)

“مِثْقَالٌ” (*misqaal*): anything against which anything is weighed, therefore any weight (or measure) can be called “مِثْقَالٌ” (*misqaal*) as in 4:40 {T}.

“ثَقُلَ” (*saqul*): to be heavy {T}

7:187	He is weighty in the skies and the earth	ثَقُلْتُ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
7:189	the woman's pregnancy became known	أَثْقَلَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ وَثَقُلْتُ

“اِثْقَالَ” (*issaqal*): to bend due to weight, to be lazy, to be late, as in 9:38. {R}

“مُثْقَلٌ” (*musqal*): burdened with weight as used in 52:40 or “مُثْقَلَةٌ” (*musqalah*) as in 35:18.

Surah *At-Taubah* says:

9:41	when you are called for jihad, then whether you are in abundance (i.e. well-to-do position) or whether you are pinched (in a sorry state), go for jihad	إِنْفِرُوا خِفَافًا وَثِقَالًا
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Taj-ul-Uros says it also means the young and the old. It can also mean the swift and the lazy, and those who are partially or fully armed. “ثَقُلْتُ مَوَازِينَهُ” (*saqolat mawazeenohu*), See heading (*Kh-F-F*).

Th-L-Th ث ل ث

“الثُّلُثُ” (*salas*), “الثُّلُثُ” (*as-solusu*): one third (1/3) of something.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:11	Then one third for his mother	فَلِأُمِّهِ الثُّلُثُ
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“الثُّلُثَانِ” (*as-solosani*) is the two third (2/3) of something.

“ثَلَاثُ” (*salasas*): the horse that finishes third in a race right after “مُصَلَّى” (*musalli*). (“مُصَلَّى” (*musalli*) is the runner up right behind the winner).

“الثَّلَاثَةُ” (*as-salasa*): as male, the count of three.

“ثَلَاثٌ” (*salas*): feminine form of three.

The Quran says:

2:196	The fasting of three days	فَصِيَامُ ثَلَاثَةِ أَيَّامٍ
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“ثُلَاثٌ” (*solas*): up to three. The Quran says:

4:3	Up to two and three and four	مِثْقَلِ ثُلَاثٍ وَرُبْعٍ
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“الثَّلَاثِينَ وَثَلَاثُونَ” (*as-salaseen was-salason*): thirty.

Th-L-L ث ل ل

“الْثَلَّةُ” (*as-sallah*): a lot of sheep and goats. Actually it means a lot of wool, since sheep also have wool on their backs; their flock is called “ثَلَّةٌ” (*salsalah*).

“حَبْلُ ثَلَّةٍ” (*hablu salah*): a rope of wool.

“الْثَلَّةُ” (*as-sullah*): a group of men.

Quran says:

56:13	a big group in the antecedents	ثَلَّةٌ مِنَ الْأَوَّلِينَ
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”تَلَّ لَدَارَ“ (*salad-daar*): to take out the earth from the foundation and then to push it (the structure) down.
 ”بَيْتٌ مَثْلُولٌ“ (*baitun maslool*): a demolished house.
 ”الْإِلَّةُ“ (*as-sillah*): annihilation {*T, M, R*}, to be turned into a heap.

Th-M-D ث م د

”الْأَمْدُ“ (*as-samd*), ”الْأَمَدُ“ (*as-samado*), ”الْأَمَادُ“ (*as-simaad*): a little water that accumulates somewhere, but not a stream, as rainwater.

”الْأَمْدُ الْمَاءُ“ (*asmadal ma'aa*): preserved rainwater etc. in ditches {*T*}.

”الْأَمِيدُ“ (*as-saamid*): four legged animal or human child which has started eating a little. This is its initial age.

Researchers have divided the human race into three big divisions:

- 1) Aryai (Aryans)
- 2) Mongol
- 3) Semitic.

The *Saami* nations are the *Arabs* the *Aramis* (Aramaic) are the *Hebrews*, the *Syriacs* and the Caledonians etc. The Quran has discussed the Messengers which belong to the *Saamis*. According to the *Torah*, *Saamis* was the name of one of *Noah's* sons. His descendants are called *Saamis*. According to modern research, the *Saami's* first homeland was Arabia from where they spread out to Babylon, Syria and Egypt etc. The most famous tribe among them who established their rule in inland Arabia was *Samood*. *Samood* literally means in front, before. Some think they were called *Samood* because there was shortage of water and they existed on rainwater {*T*}: They ruled north western Arabia which was named *Quraa*. Hijr was their capital and was situated on the ancient road from *Hijaz* to Syria. The surrounding areas of *Quraa* are very fertile but are composed of lava flow. This nation was known for big palaces and for carving out solid mountains as forts which were sculptural masterpieces. (15:83, 7:74).

As God created Man, He also spread out means of his sustenance on earth so that each could partake as he needs, but usurpers take control of these fountainheads of sustenance, and this results in the weaker dying of hunger. The purpose of the Messengers was also to get these fountainheads of sustenance out of the control of these usurpers and to make them accessible for all.

In ancient times (and today as well with the gypsies and the mount dwellers) grazing lands and water holes are the basic fountainheads of sustenance. In the nation of *Samood* too, this was the situation. The tribal heads controlled the streams of water, and the weaker human beings had to look up to them as they were dependent on them for water. To remove this inequity from society, *Saleh* was sent to them (7:73) who told them not to create such inequities in society (7:74). The weaker section of the population supported *Saleh*, but the wealthy opposed him strongly and told him in return that they will not allow any changes in what their elders followed. It seems that *Saleh* also had some say because he got the powerful people to agree to take turns and he worked out a pact with them whereby all (the rich and the poor) could get their animals to drink in turn from the streams.

Saleh said that if they honored the pact, he would let his camel loose and if it is allowed in its turn to drink from the stream, then that would prove that they would honor the pact (7:73). However, they killed the camel and thus breached the pact (went back on their word) (7:77). This camel was a material symbol of Allah and that is why it was called ”نَاقَةُ اللَّهِ“ (*naqatullah*), the camel of God, and hence a sign (7:73). They were living a very luxurious life when suddenly there was a blast in the volcanoes, a scream, a thunder roared in the air and the *Samood* nation's dwellings turned to dust. It became heaps of rubble (7:78). The details can be found in my book *Joo-e-Noor* in the tale about *Noah*.

Th-M-R ث م ر

”تَمْرٌ“ (*samar*) is the fruits of a tree, goods (wealth) of all kinds, gold or silver.

“أَنْتَمَرَّةٌ” (*as-samrah*): the tree itself, and is also used for one’s offspring.
 “مَالٌ تَمَرٌ” (*maalun samar*): wealth in abundance (that which increases very quickly).
 “تَمَرُ النَّبَاتِ” (*samaran nabaat*): the plant shed the flower and in its place the fruit appeared.

Ibn Faris says the root means anything which is born of another in consolidated form. Later it was also used allegorically.

The Quran also uses this word to mean wealth and riches in 18:34 as “كَانَ لَهُ تَمَرٌ” (*kana lahu samara*). It is also used for the bee that sucks juices from all the fruits or “تَمَرَاتٌ” (*samaraat*) in 16:69.

Raghib writes that “تَمَرٌ” (*samara*) is on top of all parts of the tree which can be tasted or eaten, thus “تَمَرًا” (*samara*) includes flowers etc. which can also be eaten.

Samma ثَمَّ

“ثَمَّ” (*samma*) is used to point at something, like ‘that’ in English {*T, L*}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:165	whichever way you face, you will find before you the path that will take you to the destination destined by Allah	فَأَيُّ مَآثِلُوا فَتَمَّ وَجْهُ اللَّهِ
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Allah’s law can be found in every aspect of life. Here the personality of God could also be ment, but His personality comes before us in the shape of His signs. The basis of these verses or signs is the law of Allah. See heading (*W-J-He*).

Surah *Ash-Shura*, Surah *Ad-Dahar*, and Surah *At-Takweer* says:

26:64	We brought the others near there too	وَأَرْفَعْنَا ثَمَّ الْآخِرِينَ
76:20	when you see there (or that way) you will find blessings	إِذَا رَأَيْتَ ثَمَّ رَأَيْتَ نَعِيمًا
81:21	He is belonging and trustee as well	مُطَاعٍ ثَمَّ أَمِينٍ

“ثَمَّ” (*samma*) can also be a verb with different meanings, such as to correct, to trample, to collect etc.

Summa ثَمَّ (حرف)

“ثَمَّ” (*summa*) is usually used where some sort of arrangement is narrated, for instance, he ate the food, then drank some water.

Surah *Al-Momineen* says:

23:32	then We dimensioned another generation after that	ثَمَّ أَنشَأْنَا مِنْ بَعْدِهِمْ قَرْنًا آخَرِينَ
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But it is not necessary for “ثَمَّ” (*summa*) to be used for relaying arrangement or order only. It can be used to mean ‘and’. For instance in surah *Yunus* it is said:

10:46	and God is witness to what they do	ثَمَّ اللَّهُ شَهِيدٌ عَلَىٰ مَا يَفْعَلُونَ
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Another clear example is in surah *Al-Baqrah*:

2:26	Allah is the One who created all that is on earth, and then (summa) He turned towards the skies and corrected them in varied forms of different spheres.	هُوَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ لَكُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ جَمِيعًا ثَمَّ اسْتَوَىٰ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ فَسَوَّاهُنَّ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ
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If “ثَمَّ” (*summa*) here is to be taken to mean ‘then’, it would mean that the order is such that He first created the earth and then the sky, but surah *An-Nazeya* mentions the celestial spheres first:

79:29	he raised the sky and corrected it	رَفَعَ سَمَكَهَا فَسَوَّاهَا
79:29	and threw the earth after it	وَالْأَرْضَ بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ دَحَاهَا

This shows that first the celestials or the spheres of the skies were created, then the earth was thrown afar. That the spheres were thrown like drops is also confirmed by 21:30. It is evident therefore that “ثُمَّ” (*summa*) is not used for any sort of order, as such it will not mean order at all places. Sometimes it will also mean ‘and’.

Sometimes it is redundant, as in surah *At-Taubah*:

9:118	till they came to believe that the earth despite being very vast had no place for them and they were fed up of themselves; and they came to believe that except Allah, nobody will save them from Allah’s punishment, then God turned towards them.	حَتَّىٰ إِذَا ضَاقَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ الْأَرْضُ --- ثُمَّ تَابَ عَلَيْهِمُ
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Here “ثُمَّ” (*summa*) has no meaning, it is hence redundant. See the book’s foreword for the meaning of “زائد” (*za-id*) or redundant. “ثُمَّ” (*summa*) also means “on top of that”, “despite”, “even so”, “although”:

16:83	They recognize the favor of Allah, and then they deny it.	يَعْرِفُونَ نِعْمَةَ اللَّهِ ثُمَّ يُنْكِرُونَهَا
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Th-M-N ث م ن

“ثَمَنُ الثَّيِّءِ” (*samanush shaiyi*): that after payment of which one can become the owner. Usually “ثَمَنُ” (*saman*) is the price at which both buyer and seller agree upon, while “قيمة” (*qeema*) is the remuneration which is actually commensurate with that thing. “مَتَاعٌ ثَمِينٌ” (*mata-un sameen*): precious goods {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

2:41	don’t sell My signs for a small price	وَلَا تَشْتَرُوا بِهَا آيَاتِي ثَمَنًا قَلِيلًا
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This doesn’t mean that they should be sold at a high price. The meaning is that their real price or “قيمة” (*qeema*) is the result which is received by following them (the signs), any price beside this will be too little. It is the worst form of crime to make *Deen* a means of personal gain. Religious monasticism is based on this. As such the Quran has it that the rebellious one said:

2:118	I will definitely take an ordained share from your followers	لَا تَجِدُنِي مِنْ عِبَادِكَ نَصِيبًا مَفْرُوضًا
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This is the same thing as “مَتَاعٌ فِي الدُّنْيَا” (*mataun fidduniya*) in 10:69. The benefits for a man in this physical world without considering the future, are anyway very little (4:77), regardless the level of quantity. This, because benefits and possessions which do not contribute to a man’s development, do not hold any weight in the human scale. The mutual conspiracy of the religious leaders is for this very benefit (29:25). This is why monasticism and Islam are considered to be opposites.

“ثَمَانِيَّةٌ” (*samaniah*): eight (masculine).
“ثَمَانِيَّةٌ أَيَّامٌ” (*samaniah ayyam*): eight days (69:7).
“ثَمَانٍ يَا ثَمَانِي” (*samanin baa samani*): eight (feminine).
“ثَمَانِي حِجَجٌ” (*samaniya hijaj*): eight years (28:237).
“ثَمَانُونَ” (*samanoon*), “ثَمَانِينَ” (*samaneen*): eighty.
“ثَمَانِينَ جَلْدَةً” (*samaneena jaldah*): eighty lashes (24:4).
“الثَّمْنُ” (*as-sumun*), “الثَّمَنُ” (*as-samn*), “الثَّمِينُ” (*as-sameen*): eighth part of anything.
“فَالِ الثَّمْنُ” (*fala hunnas sumun*): for them is the eighth share or part (4:12).

Mirza Abul Fazal with reference to *Sir Syed Ahmed Khan* has written in his book *Gharibul Quran*, that this word is sometimes used merely for garnishing, where its meaning is indefinite like ‘many’.

“تَنَاهَ” (*sanah*), “تَنِيَا” (*sania*): to double something or fold it, like cloth, or to double something by bending it, (like a branch of a tree).

“تَنَى السَّيِّءَ” (*sanash shaiyi*): bend or fold something.

“تَنَى” (*tasana*): the thing is bent.

“تَنَى الْحَيَّةَ” (*siniul hayya*): for the snake to bend or wriggle.

“الْمَتَانِي مِنَ الْوَادِي” (*al-misani minal wadi*): the bend in the valley, the plural is “الْمَتَانِي مِنَ الدَّابِّ” (*al masani minad da'abba*): the knees and forelegs of a four legged animal which are folded and doubled {T}.

“تَنَاءَ” (*sinaun*): the rope with which the thigh of a camel is secured after bending its knee {L}.

“تَنَى” (*sinyun*): a thing which is repeated again and again.

“الْأَتْنَانِ” (*al-isnaan*): two, double than one {T}. “الْأَتْنَانِ” (*isnataan*), “الْأَتْنَانِ” (*isnatain*) are feminine forms.

“فَوْقَ الْأَتْنَانِ” (*fauqas natain*): more than two (women) (4:11).

“اِتْنَاءَ الْكَلَامِ” (*asnaul kalam*): in the middle of some speech.

“فِي أَتْنَاءِ ذَلِكَ” (*fi asna-ee zalik*): in the meanwhile.

“اِسْتِنَاءَ” (*istisna'a*): to exempt someone to separate {T}.

Ibn Faris says the root basically means:

- 1) To repeat something
- 2) To make two separate things out of one.

The Quran says about the hypocrites:

11:5	they have doubled their chests (they fold it so that something is on top (fold) and something else in the bottom (fold))	أَلَا إِنَّهُمْ يَمُشُونَ مَثُورًا
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In other words, they have dual personality. In surah *Al-Hajj*, it is said about those who want to avoid the Quran:

22:9	he turns away his face (tries to avoid)	ثَانِي عَظْمِهِ
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Surah *Al-Qalam* says that the capitalists who face destruction:

68:18	do not take out what is the right of others (they will keep nothing for others only themselves)	لَا يَسْتَنْوُونَ
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In surah *Al-Hijr*, the Messenger is told to:

15:87	We endowed you with <i>sab'un minal misani</i> and the great Quran	وَلَقَدْ آتَيْنَاكَ سَبْعًا مِنَ الْمَتَانِي وَالْقُرْآنَ الْعَظِيمَ
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The great Quran is that set of Allah's laws according to which acts formulate their own results. See heading (*Ain-Dh-M*), and “الْمَتَانِي” (*al-misani*) are those historic truths which keep repeating themselves. On the one hand Allah has stated those basic principles which lead to the rise or fall of nations (through the Quran), and on the other has supported them with historical events which kept taking place during every era. To test the historic truths related by the Quran, one can study the history of mankind to see that what happened to the nations when they followed the path of righteousness as described by the Quran, and what resulted when they followed the unjust, mentioned by the Quran.

For more details see the argument about “مُحْكَمَاتٌ” (*mohkamaat*) and “مُتَشَابِهَاتٌ” (*mutashabihat*) under heading (*H-K-M*).

Surah *Al-Zumr* says about the Quran:

39:23	A book with an inner harmony as its fundament	كِتَابًا مُتَشَابِهًا مَّثَانِي
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As mentioned earlier, “مُتَّابِي” (*misani*): things which face each other (like the elbows and knees of four-legged animals which when bent, come face to face), and “مُتَّشَابِهًا” (*mutashabehan*): similar to each other.

The entire teaching of the Quran, from one end to another, is uniform. There is no contradiction in it, but in order to make its meaning clear it brings opposites face to face so that things may become clear. For instance, “ظُلُمَتْ” (*zulumaat*) against “نُورٌ” (*noor*), or darkness against light. Death against life. *Imaan* against *kufir*, or belief against denial. That is, it brings opposites face to face to make things explicit. As such the Quran is “مُتَّشَابِهًا” (*mutashabiha*) as well as “مُتَّابِي” (*masani*), which means similar and dissimilar as well. It is a book in which one thing is linked to another, but the meaning is sometimes explained by bringing opposites face to face. For more details, see headings (*Sh-B-He*), and (*H-K-M*).

“مُتَّابِي” (*masna*): in groups of two (35:1), (4:3).

“إِنْتَا عَشَرَ” (*asna ashar*) is the masculine form.

“إِنْتَا عَشْرَةَ” (*isnata ashrah*) is the feminine form as in (2:60) for twelve.

“كِتَابًا مُتَّشَابِهًا مَّثَانِي” (*kitabun mutashabehan masani*) can also mean “similar to the former” (books of God) and in a way their reiteration.

Th-W-B

ث و ب

“تَّابٌ” (*sab-aa*), “يَتُوبُ” (*yasoob*), “تَوْبًا” (*sauban*): to return, to turn back after leaving.

“تَّابَ جِسْمُهُ تَوْبَانًا وَأَتَّابٌ” (*sa'ba jismuhu saubanan wa asaba*): his body came back to its natural form after illness and thus his strength and health got recovered {*T, M*}.

“تَّابَ الْمَاءُ” (*sabal ma'o*): took the water out but it got refilled, was restored {*T*}

“الَّتَّابُ مِنَ الْبَحْرِ” (*as saibo minal bahar*): after ebbing, the water which remains of the sea.

“بِعَرْ تَيْبٌ” (*berun saib*): the well in which water comes back (after drying up).

Kitabul Ashqaa says that “تَّابَ يَتُوبُ” (*saaba yasoob*): “رَجَعَ” (*ra-jah*) or to return.

“كُلُّ رَاجِعٍ تَائِبٌ” (*kullo raje-in sayebun*): everyone who returns. *Ibn Faris* too says this is its meaning.

“مَتَّابَةُ الْبَيْرِ” (*masabatul beyr*): as far as the water of the well reaches.

“الْمَتَّابَةُ” (*al-masabah*): the spot where the gathering takes place again and again, centre, house, or destination.

“تَّابَ النَّاسُ” (*saaban naas*): the people gathered {*T, M*}.

“النَّوْبُ” (*as-saub*): cloth, probably because the shuttle comes and goes repeatedly in the making of a cloth.

Its plural is “تَيَّابٌ” (*siyaab*).

“تَوَّابٌ” (*sawwab*): one who sells cloth {*T, M*}.

The Arabs usually take “تَيَّابٌ” (*siyaab*) to mean a man's personality, that is, the one who wears the clothes himself. So they say “فُلَانٌ دَنِسٌ التَّيَّابُ” (*fulan danis sus siyaab*): that man has a mean personality, his personality is very bad {*T, M*}.

“تَتَوَّبُ” (*tasweeb*): to call out to people, to make them assemble. As such, in the call to morning prayer, they say “الصَّلَاةُ خَيْرٌ مِنَ النَّوْمِ” (*salato khairum minan naum*): praying is better than sleeping. This is also called “تَتَوَّبُ” (*tasweeb*) {*T*}.

“تَّابَ يَتُوبُ” (*saaba yasoob*): to understand the right meanings, one has to recall the meanings given at first.

“تَّابٌ” (*saab*): for a thing to go first and then return. Whatever you do, something is used up in it. If nothing else, then your bodily strength, time and mental faculties may be used. If the work you do is useless, then all your strengths that are used up in it also go waste. If it produces some result, then whatever strengths you invested, get compensated. This restoration is called “تَوَّابٌ” (*sawwab*).

Obviously it is not just a thought. Whatever you use up, is felt very much by you; either it is time that is spent or physical or mental strength. Therefore whatever is restored must also be felt, otherwise how will you know that the restoration has taken place? That is why when the Quran says “تَوَّابُ الْآخِرَةِ” (*sawabil akhirah*), which is the compensation in Hereafter (3:144), it also mention “تَوَّابُ الدُّنْيَا” (*sawabud duniyah*) compensation in life (3:147).

In order to remove any doubts, it is also explained that this “تَوَابٌ” (*sawab*) will be in the shape of luxuries, like power and leadership, thick and fine silken clothes, and victories etc. (18:31). Quran has said that the result of good deeds without failure, are the domination and riches in this world (24:55). Thus “تَوَابٌ” (*sawaab*) should be manifest in this world as a first step. Later in the Hereafter as well, since all these are due to good deeds, that is why “تَوَابٌ” (*sawaab*) is the result of our good deeds.

This word “تَوَابٌ” (*sawaab*) is generally used for good results but sometimes it is used for the results of bad deeds as well, as in 83:36 and in 3:152. In these verses it mean for man to return to whatever he has done.

83:36	the deeds of the deniers return to them as the result	هَلْ تُؤْتُونَ الْكُفَّارَ مَا كَانُوا يَفْعَلُونَ
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The Quran has explained this very fine point that acts are themselves their own compensation. For example, you go for morning walk, walk for two or three miles in which you use up your energy as well as time. In return you get good health and freshness etc. This health and freshness is the result of your walk, i.e. your walk itself is its own result or reward. This is “تَوَابٌ” (*sawaab*) which makes it clear how wrong “إِصَالِ تَوَابٍ” (*eesaali sawaab*) (the practice of trying to transfer the “تَوَابٌ” (*sawaab*) or result of good deeds to someone, usually dead) is. Can it be that you take the walk and transfer the results to me? It is impossible to do so! If you take the walk, the benefits will accrue only to you. If I do not take the walk, then it can do no good for me. Despite desperately wanting to transfer the benefits to another, you cannot do that. Therefore, transferring “تَوَابٌ” (*sawaab*) to another is a dubious belief and seems to have no connection with the Quran. Everyone gets the result of their own deeds, which they can't transfer to anyone else.

“مُتَوَبِّهٌ” (*masoobah*): result or the natural cycle of events (5:60).

Quran has addressed the Messenger to say:

74:4	And your <i>siyab</i> purified	وَتَيَّابَكَ فَطَهَّرَ
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We have seen that this word “تَيَّابٌ” (*siyab*) is used for personality. Quran itself, at another place, has used this word for personality, or human thought, as in 71:7, and 11:5. That is why it also means that you should keep your personality clean of any pollution, and if *tasweeb*'s meaning is kept in mind, then it would mean to keep your invitation (to trust in Allah and His Rusool) away from those who have the pollution of duplicity or hypocrisy in their hearts. Therefore there is a connotation of keeping your personality clean rather than keeping the clothes clean. For another meaning of “تَوَابٌ” (*sawaab*) see the heading “سُدَى” (*sudya*).

Th-W-R ث و ر

“الْتَوْرَانُ” (*as-sauran*): agitation.

“تَارَ السَّيِّ” (*saaras shaiyi*): that thing was agitated.

“تَارَ الْغُبَارُ” (*saaral ghubar*): the dust rose and spread out.

“قَدَّ تَارَاهُ” (*qad sara sairohu*): that man got furious.

“أَتَارَهُ وَتَوَّرَهُ وَاسْتَتَارَهُ” (*asarohu wa saurahu wastasarah*): he roused him, agitated him.

“أَتَارَ الْأَرْضَ” (*asaral ard*): ploughed the land and turned it upside down {T}.

The Quran says:

100:4	those horses hit the earth with their hooves and raised dust	فَأَتَرْنَ بِهِ تَفْعًا
2:71	this ox has not been harnessed in the plough	لَا دُلُولَ لِيَوْمِهِ الْأَرْضِ
30:38	they agitate the clouds and lift them	فَيُثِيرُ سَحَابًا

Ibn Faris says the root means for something to be lifted.

”تَوَى الْمَكَانَ“ (*sawal makaan*): stayed at some place for long, got down for permanent residence.

”الْمَنْوَى“ (*al-maswa*): residence, staying place, a place of permanent residence.

”أَبُو مَنْوَى“ (*abu-maswa*): host, guest, the resident.

”الْمَنْوَى“ (*as-savi*): guest, also guestroom.

”أَتَوَاهُ“ (*aswah*): hosted him.

”الْمَنْوَى“ (*asuwwah*): a resting place for camels near ones house. Also see heading (*A-W-Y*). It is also called as ”السَّوِيَّةُ“ (*sawaiyah*) {*T, R, Lataiful Lugha*}.

Surah *Al-Qasas* and *Yousuf* says:

28:45	You were not staying with the people of <i>Madyan</i>	وَمَا كُنْتَ تَأْوِيًا فِي أَهْلِ مَدْيَنَ
12:21	Keep it with respect (give him a place of respect)	أَكْرِمْنِي مَثْوًى

The connotations of permanent residence and hosting shows that the ruler of Egypt had already hosted *Yusuf* respectfully, and that he was not kept as an ordinary slave.

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says:

3:150	The residence of the mutinous is (hell) indeed a very bad place.	بُئْسَ مَثْوًى الظَّالِمِينَ
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”النَّيْبُ“ (*as-sayib*): a woman who is no longer with her husband (either divorced or a widow) {*T*}.

The Quran uses ”نَيْبَاتٍ“ (*sayyeba*) as against ”أَبْكَارَ“ (*abkaar*) which means an unmarried woman i.e. a spinster (66:5)

”بئرُ نَيْبٍ“ (*be'roon sayyib*): the well in which water returns after drying up.

”نَيْبَاتِ الْمَرْأَةِ وَنَنْيِبَتِ“ (*sayyabatil mar'ato wa tasayyibat*): the woman was widowed {*T*}.

“جَوَّارُ” (*juwaar*): to call out loudly and to make a noise, regardless if this act is carried out by a human or animal. This means that it can be used for loud chanting and also for a cow to make noises.

“الْجَوَّارُ” (*al-juwar*) also means “خَوَّارُ” (*khuwar*): for an ox to make noises.

“جَارُ الدَّاعِي يَجَارُ” (*jaraddayi bajar*): to raise one’s voice while praying.

“جَارُ الرَّجُلِ إِلَى اللَّهِ” (*jarar rajulu ilal lah*): he pleaded while praying before God {*T*}.

It is said at times of great stress while praying or pleading {*R*}.

Quran says when you are in trouble, then

16:53	You shout out, and plead before God	فَإِلَيْهِ يَخَافُونَ
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Jaloot

جَالُوتُ

“جَالُوتُ” (*jaloot*) is a non-arabic word {*T, R*}. Jaloot was a mutinous leader in Palestine who was killed by the hands of *Dawood* (2:251).

Its hebrew diction is “جَلِيَّاتُ” (*Jalyat*) {*M*}. Some think that this word has come from “جَالُ” (*jaala*) and “جَالُ” (*jaala fi hurb*): that he attacked with fierceness in battle.

In English the character of Jaloot is better known as Goliath.

J-B-B

ج ب ب

“الْجُبُّ” (*al-jabb*), “الْجِبَابُ” (*al-jibaat*), “الْإِجْتَبَابُ” (*al-ijtebaab*): to cut, to delink.

“الْجُبُّ” (*al-jub*): well, very deep well, a well which is not concrete or plastered.

It is called “جُبُّ” (*jubb*) when it has not been dug by man, but a sort of ditch or hole has been formed naturally. A well which has formed on its own and not dug by man. It was this sort of well in which *Yusuf*’s brothers had put him into (12:10).

Muheet’s compiler says “جُبُّ” (*jubb*) also means a well or ditch about which it is not known how deep it is or how far down the bottom is.

Raghib says it means a deep hole or ditch whose bottom is fathomless, or a well or ditch which is dug on a hard surface.

Ibn Faris writes that the other basic meanings of this word are to collect things. This is why “الْجُبَّةُ” (*al-jubba*): the (gown-like dress of Arabs) dress because it sort of collects the entire body within it.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “الْجُبَّةُ” (*al-jubba*): a dress which is sewn from cut pieces of cloth.

J-B-T

ج ب ت

Tajul Uroos says that “الْجِبْتُ” (*al-jibt*): a statue, a sorcerer, an astrologer. Hence Taj writes with reference to Shobi that it means sorcery (magic). The root is said to be “الْجَبْسُ” (*al-jubbs*) which means anything which has no good {*T, M*}.

Muheet says it is actually derived from Siryan and means “جَوْفُ” (*maj jauf*) which means something hollow. Thereby it began to be used for any hollow or empty object. Alminar says this is as well.

Quran speaks about the people of the code (*ahli kitaab*):

4:51	They trust in sorcery and non-beneficial systems	يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْجِبِّ وَالطَّاعُوتِ
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They trust in mutinous and the man-made laws and the forces which implement those laws and “جِبَّتْ” (*jibt*) which is any unimportant thing, superstitions, spiritless traditions and which have become hollow inside.

Any nation which turns away from Allah’s law thinks “جِبَّتْ” (*jibt*) and “طَاغُوتْ” (*taghoot*), or sorcery, are powers to be worshipped.

J-B-R

ج ب ر

“الْجَبْرُ” (*al-jabr*) basically it means to reform something in a way which needs force.

“الْجَبَائِرُ” (*al-jabair*): the splints used for mending broken bones.

“بَرَّ الْعَظْمُ” (*jabaral azm*): to reset broken bones.

“الْجَابِرُ” (*al-jabir*): one who mends broken bones {*T, M, R*}.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that “ج” (*jeem*), “ب” (*ba*), “ر” (*ra*) in their various arrangements give the meaning of intensity and strength.

Ibn Faris says that this word basically signifies greatness, loftiness and stability.

“الْجَبَّارُ” (*al-jabbaar*) is one of Allah’s traits, which means the mender of all cosmic or human weakness. It also means to make one free of all needs. For instance:

“جَبَّرَ الْفَقِيرَ مِنَ الْفَقْرِ” (*jabaral faqira minal faqir*): he made the needy free of his needs.

“تَجَبَّرَ الشَّجَرُ” (*tajabbarash shajar*): the tree became green with vegetation.

“تَجَبَّرَ ارْأَمْرِيضُ” (*tajabbaral mareez*): the patient’s condition became better.

These above examples make clear what Allah’s “جَبَّارِيَّتْ” (*jabbariat*):. In other words, this too is one more aspect of His Kindness, but for this Man has to observe the path and remain within the set limit. But when human forces break the limits set by Allah, then the very streams become ferocious. That is why in this condition “جَبْرُ” (*jabr*): tyranny and “جَبَّارُ” (*jabbar*): tyrant, mutinous, and those who cross the limit.

In the Quran Hazrat Isa says:

19:32	Allah has not made me mutinous, tyrant or ill-fated	وَلَمْ يَجْعَلْنِي جَبَّارًا شَقِيًّا
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In surah Qaf, about Hazrat Muhammed it is said:

50:45	you are not one to pressure them in any way (don’t force them to agree upon anything)	وَمَا أَنْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ بِجَبَّارٍ
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About the nation of *Aad*, it is said:

26:130	when you arrest someone, then you arrest him very tyrannically	وَإِذَا بَطَشْتُمْ بَطَشْتُمْ جَبَّارِينَ
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This word has also been used for men with a big hulk in 5:22.

“الْجَبَّارُ مِنَ النَّخِيلِ” (*al-jabbaro man-nikheel*): the long date which nobody’s hand can reach

You would have noted that no force of man is good or bad in itself. It is its usage which makes it good or bad. If force is used to mend broken bones, then it is good, but if the same force is used for breaking bones, then it is bad.

“جَبَّار” (*jabbar*) which stops tyranny is a blessing of God, and the “جَبَّار” (*jabbar*) that perpetrates tyranny is the reason for punishment.

Jibreel

جِبْرِيلُ

“جِبْرِيلُ” (*Jibreel*) is a Hebrew word. In Quran it is meant to be the power that inscribes Divine inspiration (*wahi*) on the Messengers heart.

Quran says:

2:97	Say “if someone distances himself from Jibreel, who inscribed this Divine message on your heart”...	قُلْ مَنْ كَانَ عَدُوًّا لِجِبْرِيلَ فَإِنَّهُ نَزَّلَهُ عَلَى قَلْبِكَ
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“جِبْرِيلُ” (*jibreel*) is also called as “رُوحُ الْقُدُسِ” (*ruhool quddus*) (16:102) and “رُوحُ الْأَمِينِ” (*roohul ameen*) (26:193). The word “جِبْرِيلُ” (*Jibreel*) appears in *Surah Baqaraa* twice (2:97-98) and once in *Surah Tahreem* (66:4).

Since mankind cannot understand the significance of *wahi* (Divine inspiration, because *wahi* is the knowledge that has its source beyond the comprehension of mankind, therefore it cannot understand what is the essence of “جِبْرِيلُ” (*jibreel*)). Our connection with *wahi* exists in Quran and from there we can comprehend it. This energy “رُوحُ” (*roohun*) is called “قُدُسُ” (*quddusun*) and “أَمِينُ” (*ameenun*) because the Divine inspiration (which is engraved on the heart of Messengers) is neither adulterated nor has any corruption in it. Neither is there any doubt of an emotional input of the Messenger (53:3), nor is there any corruption made by Messengers themselves (3:160). None of the worldly powers can interfere with it.

The enemies of the Messengers are the ones who introduce these elements after their death (whether they may be their own kin or others). But Quran states that no adulteration or corruption is possible, because God Himself has taken on the responsibility to safeguard it.

J-B-L

ج ب ل

“الْجِبَالُ” (*Aljabalu*) is a mountain, or nation’s chief or scholar. (plural “جمع جِبَالُ” (*jeebaalun*)).

Surah Al-Anmbiyaa says:

21:79	We made the chiefs of this nation subservient to David (for the fulfillment of the purpose of life)	وَسَخَّرْنَا مَعَ دَاوُدَ الْجِبَالَ
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The same meaning is to me taken in (34:10). It could also mean that the Messenger David brought the mountainous area under his control and put to use. In *Surah Qaaf* the opposite of “الْجِبَالُ” (*al-jbaal*) is given as the “أَرْضُ” (*arz*) which means lower level. (18:47). Also see heading (*A-W-B*).

In it too “جِبَالُ” (*jibaalu*) are meant to be the chiefs, while the “أَرْضُ” (*arz*): the lesser group. “الْجِبِلُّ” (*al-jibilu*) and “الْجِبِلَّةُ” (*al-jibilatuh*) is a large group of people as in 36:62 & 26:184 {T}. “الْجِبِلَّةُ” (*al-jibillath*): a large amount, a constant mannerism, nature, crowd {M}.

Ibn Faris has said that its fundamental meaning is to be elevated and that all its various constituents to be collected permanently together. Hence “جِبَالُ” (*jibaalun*) is a collection of loftiness, status, power and community.

The common meaning of “جِبَالُ” (*jabalun*) is a mountain and its metaphorical meaning is chiefs or leaders of a nation. Thus in Quran, it is possible to ascertain which meanings are appropriate by considering the context of the verse.

“الْجُبْنُ” (*al-jubnu*), is cowardice, to be weak hearted. Also its meaning is cheese. “الْجَبِينَانِ” (*al-ajabeenaani*) is temples (both sides of forehead) where the folds occur. Its singular is “الْجَبِينُ” (*al-jabeenu*). “الْجَبِينُ” (*al-jabhatunh*) is also the fore head (this in between the temples) [T, M, R].

In Quran, with reference to Abraham and Ishmael it is given

37:103	Abraham put Ishmael on his side, of temple	وَتَلَّهُ لِلْجَبِينِ
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Same as a slaughter lays the animal down on one side to slaughter it with ease. Thus it is obvious from Quran that Abraham laid Ishmael down in the same way.

“الْجَبْهَةُ” (*al-jabhatuh*) is forehead. Its plural is “جَبَاهُ” (*jabhaau*). It also means a beautiful woman who has a broad and high forehead {T}. Muheet has said that its fundamental meaning is of lofty and tall person. Quran says “جَبَاهُهُمْ” (*jibahuhum*) in verse 9:35 to say “their foreheads”.

“جَبَى الْخِرَاجَ وَالْمَالَ” (*jabyi al khiraaja wal maala*): collected tribute and wealth.
 “جَبَى الْمَاءَ فِي الْخَوْضِ” (*jabyi al maa fi al hodh*): collected water in the fountain.
 “جَبَى الْمَاءَ فِي الْخَوْضِ” (*jabal ma'aa fil hauz*): collected water in the pool. Tts plural is “جَوَابٍ” (*jawabin*) or “الْجَابِيَةُ” (*al-jawabi*).

The fundamental meaning of this root is to collect {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

37:13		وَجَفَّانٍ كَأَلْحَابٍ
28:57	all types of fruit would be drawn towards the Kaabaa and get collected there	يُجْبَى إِلَيْهِ ثَمَرَاتُ

“جَبَا” (*jabaa*): to compile or collect.

In Surah *Al-Airaf* it is said:

7:203	when you do not take a Quranic verse to them, they say ‘why don’t you compose one your self	وَإِذَا لَمْ تَأْتِهِمْ بِآيَةٍ قَالُوا لَوْلَا جُئِيتُهُمْ
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This is said because, the non-believers had this impression that the messenger compiled (God forbid) the Quranic verses by collecting hearsay.

Even today the Orientalist put out such ideas. This is because of their lack of knowledge regarding position of the ‘Messenger-ship’ or perhaps mere prejudice on their part. In both cases our educated people were badly affected by such writings.

“الْإِجْتِبَاءُ” (*al-ijteebaau*) is to collect wealth from the source and horde it, (meaning the collected tribute). Thus it is deduced that it means, to selectively collect {T, M, R}, as given in verse 3:178 “اللَّهُ يَجْتَبِي” (Allah reclaims).

“الْجُثُّ” (*al-jaththu*) is to uproot a tree from its roots.

“الْجُثَّتْ” (*al-jiththaathu*): the same, but even with more emphases {T, M, R}. In Quran we have “الْجُثَّتْ” (*ujtuththu*) in verse 14:26, which means ‘its roots and base was uprooted’.

“الْجُثُّ” (*al-juththu*) is a hill which is reduced to a small mound.

“جُثَّةُ الْإِنْسَانِ” (*juththul al insaani*) is when a person is sitting or lying down, and thus his body quizzes to small size (*Ibn Faris*).

Ibn Faris states that its fundamental meaning is to collect. The same applies to uprooted tree as it is collected in small bundle so that it does not sprout again.

“جَثَمَ” (*jathama*), “يَجْثِمُ” (*yajthimu*), “جَثْمًا” (*jathman*) and “جُثُومًا” (*juthoomu*) is to cling such as not to separate again. For birds etc. to sit on their chest, so as not to move from the place is said “الْجَاثِمُ” (*al-jaathimu*).

“الْجُثْمَةُ” (*al-juthmatuh*) is a mound of soil, mud or ash.

“الْجُثُومُ” (*al-juthoomu*) and “الْجَثَمَةُ” (*al-jathamatah*) is a hillock.

“الْمُجَثَّمَةُ” (*al-mujaththamatuh*) is the animal that is tethered so as to take an aim at it for the purpose of killing it {T}. Therefore it means to collect in a place and be made immobile {F}.

In Quran is given:

7:78	they remained static in their houses and turned into mounds	فَأَصْبَحُوا فِي دَارِهِمْ جَثِيمِينَ
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“الْجُثْوَةُ” (*al-jathwatuh*) (with all three vowels on J) a mound of stones or sand, and also body.

“الْجُثْوَةُ” (*juthaa al harami*) is the mound of pebbles that is collected at the limits of the “” (*haram*) to be thrown at the Devil. The idols, on which the sacrificial animals were slaughtered, during the pagan period.

“الْجَثَا” (*al-juthaa*) is a community (collection) of people.

“جَاثَوْتُ الْإِبِلَ” (*jathawtu al ibila*): ‘I have collected the camels’.

“جَاثَا” (*Jathaa*), “يَجْثَوُ” (*yajtho*), “جُثْيًا” (*jutheeyan*) is to squat (for the purposes of quarrel).

“فَهُوَ جَاثٌ” (*fahuwa jaathin*): that someone squatted on knees (plural is “جُثْيٌ” (*juthiyyun*) and also “جُثْيٌ” (*jithiyan*) {T}.

In *Surah Jaathiyaa* it is given:

45:28	you will see all groups squatting on their knees (in disgrace, humility and helpless ness.)	وَنَذَرُ الظَّالِمِينَ فِيهَا جَاثِيًا
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In *Surah Maryam* it is given:

19:27	We will place the ignorant on their knees	وَنَذَرُ الظَّالِمِينَ فِيهَا جَاثِيًا
19:68	We will present them around hell on their knees (in total disgrace)	لَنُخْضِرَنَّ لَهُمْ جَوْلًا جَهَنَّمَ جَاثِيًا

“جَدَّ حَقَّهُ” (*jhada haqqahu*), is to deliberately deny some one’s right.
 “أَرْضٌ جَدَّةٌ” (*ardhun jahidatunh*) is dry land.
 “عَامٌ جَدٌّ” (*a’mun jahidun*) is the year with below average rain.
 “أَجَدَّ الرَّجُلُ” (*ajhadal rajulu*) is uttered when one loses everything and gets up dejected to leave {T}.

Ibn Faris has said that it means the draught (shortage) of blessings, or of good things.

Raghib and **Muheet** have said that “الْجَدُّ” (*al-jahdu*): to deny that which the heart believes in, and vice versa.

In various places Quran has referred to those who deny Divine laws merely on account of the intentional stubbornness “بَايَاتِ اللَّهِ يُجْحَدُونَ” (6:33).

This is explained elsewhere as in following verse:

27:14	these people deny the truth deliberately, merely on account of their lack of knowledge and arrogance, although they know very well that it is the truth	وَجَحَدُوا بِهَا وَاسْتَيْقَنَتْهَا أَنْفُسُهُمْ ظُلْمًا وَعُلُوًّا
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Muheet has said that “جَدَّ النُّعْمَةِ” (*hajada al ne’matih*): that he has not understood it or deliberately is ungrateful of the blessings.

“أَجَحَمَ عَنْهُ” (*ajhama anhu*): that he was stopped from whatever he was doing.
 “الْجَحَامُ” (*al-hjjam*) is used for a miser who stops his wealth from spreading {T}.
 “الْبَعِيرُ” (*al-bai’yur*): to put a muzzle on a camel’s mouth to stop it from biting.
 “تَجَحَّمَ الْمَكَانُ وَالْقَلْبُ” (*tajahhama al makaanu walqalbu*): the house, or the heart got constricted {M}.

Imam al Ramanyi has given “أَجَحَمَ” (*ajhama*), “أَمْسَكَ” (*amsaka*) and “إِنْهَى” (*intahaa*) as synonyms.

Ibn Faris has said that this word in its meaning is an inversion.

“تَجَحَّمَ” (*tajahamma*): to grow bitter as the consequences of one’s miserliness and constriction of heart.
 From this is deduced as, to set aflame.
 “الْجَحْمَةُ” (*al-jahmatuh*) is the fire in a deep place. Therefore it means a very hot place.
 “الْجَاهِمُ مِنَ الْحَرْبِ” (*al jaahimu minal harbī*): a very fierce battle {T}.

Ibn Faris has given its meaning as very hot and intense fire.

Quran has used this word for the state of Hell (see 44:27, 37:55, 37:64, 37:68). Quran has given the result of ‘wrong doing’ as the fire of hell because it burns everything to ashes.

If the purpose of life is considered in the light of Quran, it will be obvious that this worldly life is a link in the chain of development and this progress has a long way yet to travel. In following the divine laws, human being reaches a certain level of progress and development eventually in the hereafter. But if its capabilities are not able to travel the distance then it is not able to reach that level. It comes to a halt. This is the fundamental rule of natural progress. This halting is referred to in Quran as “الْجَحِيمُ” (*al-jaheemu*), which fundamentally means to come to a halt.

“الْجَحِيمُ” (*al-jaheemu*) is hence the last stop on the path of its journey. And because this heat of realization is so intense, it burns the heart (104:7-8) to the extent that it will turn its dreams to ashes. According to

Quran, an individual or a nation that come to such a halt, that place is called “الْجَحِيمُ” (*jaheem*). Life is a continuous flow that has to keep on flowing, but the flow which comes to a halt, starts getting stale.

J-D-Th

ج د ث

“الْجَدْتُ” (*al-jadas*): grave. Its plural form is “الْجُدُ” (*ajdus*) and “الْجَدَاتُ” (*ajudas*).

The Quran says about those in the state of *Janannum*:

36:51	They will suddenly get out of their graves and sped towards their lord.	فَإِذَا هُمْ مِنَ الْأَجْدَاثِ إِلَىٰ رَبِّهِمْ يَنْسِلُونَ
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This is followed up with the following verse where these same people shall say:

36:56	Who woke us up from our resting place?	كَمْ هُمْ بَعَثْنَا مِنْ مَرْقَدِنَا
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Hence “الْجَدْتُ” (*ajadas*) and “مَرْقَدٌ” (*maroqad*) have same meanings. Please not that these words are not confined for some specific places, but rather conditions.
“الْجَدْنَةُ” (*al-dajasa*) is the sound a camels foot makes while striking the ground.

J-D-D

ج د د

“الْجَدُّ” (*al-jadda*). The basic meaning of this root is to complete or cut off something. For instance, “تَوْبٌ جَدِيدٌ” (*saub jadeed*): the recently cut cloth. But soon its use began to mean every newly prepared or new-born thing {T}. “الْجَدِيدُ” (*al-jadeed*) is used for a thing with you previously never had any knowledge of.

The Quran says:

14:20	If He would desire, He could replace you with a new creation. (a creation which you have no knowledge of)	إِنْ يَشَأْ يُدْهِبْكُمْ وَيَأْتِ بِخَلْقٍ جَدِيدٍ
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“الْجُدَّةُ” (*al-jodda*): the way of anything, which is the way of its completion. The plural is “جُدَدٌ” (*joda*).

The Quran use this word in mention of mountains:

35:27	Roads of color red and white	جُدَدٌ بَيْضٌ وَحُمْرٌ
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Here the ways are referring to the lines of rocky layers of different colors, on which the mountains are constructed. In this regard “الْجُدَّةُ” (*al-jodda*) is also used for the lines on a donkey back.

“الْجَدُّ” (*al-jaddo*) also means soil or field, and also for a very blessed man. It also means grandfather. It is to this regard that its meanings are maturity, greatness and high status as well.

The Quran hence says:

72:3	The status of our <i>Rabb</i> is extremely great.	وَإِنَّهُ تَعَالَىٰ جَدُّ رَبِّنَا
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“الْجِدُّ” (*al-jidda*) to make an effort in any work. It also means to hurry or do something quickly. In addition to this, this word is also used to express exaggeration, for instance “عَالِمٌ جِدُّ عَالِمٍ” (*alimun jidda alim*): he is a scholar, indeed a great scholar {T}.

Ibn Faris says that this root has three basic meanings:

- High status
- Well blessed
- Completion by cutting.

All three meanings have been presented with examples in the above text.

“الْجَدْرُ” (*al-jadro*), “الْجِدَارُ” (*al-jidar*): wall. “الْحَائِطُ” (*al-haito*) is used to cover a wall.
 “الْجَدْرُ” (*al-jadar*): to be tall.

The real meaning of this root is in fact to be rise, to be tall. Hence “جَدَرْتُ الْجِدَارَ” (*jarad tul-ijara*): that the wall got taller.

“الْجَدْرُ” (*al-jadru*) is a plant that grows in sandy soil {T}.

Surah kahaf has uses the word of “جَدَارٌ” (*jadar*) in the meaning of wall (18:77).

“الْجَدِيرُ” (*al-jadeer*): to be in appropriate and suitable.

“قَدْ جَدِرَ جَدَارُهُ” (*qad jadora jadarah*): surely he got appropriate.

“إِنَّهُ مَجْدُورٌ أَنْ يَفْعَلَ ذَلِكَ” (*inna majdor an yaf'al zalika*): he is indeed suitable for this.

The Quran says:

9:97	They are more suited then this where they do not understand	وَأَجْدَرُ أَلَّا يَعْلَمُوا
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“الْجَدِيرَةُ” (*al-jadeerah*) is one's health condition.

“الْجَدْلُ” (*al-jadlo*) basically means to be twisted.

“جَدَلُ الْحَبْلِ” (*jadal-al-habla*): twisted the rope firmly.

“الْجَدِيلُ” (*al-jadeel*) is the twisted leather or rope used on horses {T}.

“الْجَدَالُ” (*al-judalo*) is used for anything that is twisted firmly {M}.

“الْجَدَلَةُ” (*al-jadalah*): firm soil {T}.

“جَدَلُ الشَّيْءِ جُدُولًا” (*judalashai judola*): to become firm and hard.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is to become long firm.

“جَدَلٌ” (*judal*) is used for a quarrel because of its long lasting.

“الْجِدَالُ” (*al-jidalo*). According to *Raghib*, this word is used for such a quarrel where participants try to dominate each other, and for that reason make the discussion long without any proper reason. This is the reason why some think that the meaning of this word is the same as of “صِرَاعٌ” (*sira'o*) which means to throw your opponent on the ground {T}.

The Quran mention the following regarding Hajj.

2:197	Don't exercise <i>jidal</i> in hajj	لَا جِدَالَ فِي الْحَجِّ
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With respect to the above given meaning of *jidal*, the purpose of hajj becomes clear. Hajj is an international gathering of Muslims with a practical purpose. The purpose is to get together to discuss and solve the mutual problems and issues. The Quran says that for this gathering do not adopt such a manner in which you try to throw down your encountering party, or prolong the discussion with useless inputs, in order to win an argument. Keep your discussions short and serious, and keep in mind the purpose, which is to discuss as much issues in least possible time.

Surah *Mujadilah* says “الَّتِي تُجَادِلُكَ” (*allitu tujadilko*). This is referring to that woman who used to constantly ask question regarding her husband, from *Rusool-Allah*. She was prolonging the discussion without any reason. She wanted to win the argument and hence the argument started to turn into something like a quarrel.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:54	And We have indeed put forth in the Quran repeatedly for mankind every kind of example (alternating the styles), but man is far ahead in contention than anything else	وَلَقَدْ صَرَّفْنَا فِي هَذَا الْقُرْآنِ لِلنَّاسِ مِنْ كُلِّ مَثَلٍ وَكَانَ الْإِنْسَانُ أَكْثَرَ شَيْءٍ جَدَلًا
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The meaning is that all aspects has been clearly defined in the holy Quran, but the true way of approach is that one should not constantly try to prove the Quranic teaching wrong, no matter what. One should keep an open mind while studying Quran, and always have this objective that I am studying Quran to learn about the facts. This is the only way to actually learn something.

J-Dh-Dh ج ذ ذ

“الْجَذُّ” (*al-jazz*): to break something.
 “كَسَرْتُهُ أَجْزَاءً” (*kasaratu ajazaza*): I smashed it into several pieces.
 “الْجُزْأَةُ” (*al-juzzah*) basically means the part of something that gets cut off.
 “جُزْأَةٌ” (*juzazu*) parts or dust of gold.

Surah *Al-Anbiya* says:

21:58	Ibrahim smashed those statues into pieces.	فَجَعَلَهُمْ جُذَاذًا
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Surah *Hood* says the following regarding the status of *Jannah*:

11:108	Not breakable gift (a gift that is not going to stop or end, which shall last forever)	عَطَاءٌ غَيْرٌ يَجْذُوذُ
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In other words

65:6	An everlasting compensation	أَجْرٌ غَيْرُ امْتَنُونِ
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J-Dh-Ain ج ذ ع

“جُذْعٌ” (*jiz'a*) is the trunk of a palm tree. Its plural is “جُذُوعٌ” (*jazo'o*).
 Some have said that this word is used for the trunk that has gone dry. Some has said that it means the trunk that has been cut off. But others think that this word does not contain concepts of drying out or get cut off.

Surah Mariam has mentioned “جُذْعَ النَّخْلَةِ” (*jiza'in nahazi*) in 19:23, to mean palm tree of dates, and 19:25 has made it clear that this palm tree is flourishing, bearing fruit. But on the other hand, surah Taha has used the words of “جُذُوعَ النَّخْلِ” (*jazo'in nahli*) for the wood of a crucifix (20:71). From this we get the indication that crucifix was made from cut off dry wood of palm trees.

“جَذَعْتُهُ” (*jaz'ah*): that I cut it off.
 “جَذَعَ الدَّابَّةَ” (*jaz'addabbah*): he cut off the animal's route.
 “الْجُدُوْعَةُ” (*al-jodo'ah*) is the young age.

Ibn Faris says that it basically means youth and freshness, trunk of a tree, to meet with something.

J-Dh-W ج ذ و

“جَذَا عَلَى الشَّيْءِ يُجْذُو جُذُوءًا” (*jaza a'lashai i yojazzo jazoa*): He established himself firmly on something.
 “جَذَا الرَّجُلُ عَلَى أَطْرَافِ أَصَابِعِهِ” (*jazzarrajolu a'la atrafi asabi'hi*): Man stood up upon his toes.

Hence it has the basic concept of standing of something on something. For that reason “جَذْوَةٌ” (*jazzwah*) is that flare of burning wood, which loses its glow. In other words, the shining and twinkling is lost and it gets settled on a condition. Quran has used “جَذْوَةٌ مِنَ النَّارِ” in 28:26 to indicate flare of a fire.

“جَرَحَ” (*jarha*): to acquire something, to get something.

Ibn Faris says that it has two basic meanings. One is earning and second is of opening the skin (to inflict wound)

The Quran says following with respect to earning:

65:6	Those who produce unbalance	أَمْ حَسِبَ الَّذِينَ أَجْرُوا حُزَا السَّيِّئَاتِ
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This above verse is referring towards those who commit crime.

Surah *Al-An'am* says:

6:60	That what you do during the daytime	مَا جَرَحْتُم بِهَا لَيْلًا
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In this context “الْجَوَارِحُ” (*al-javarih*) is used for the hands, feet or body members that work for a man.

Muheet says that “الْجَوَارِحُ” (*al-javarih*): those challenges that one makes during the daytime. Likewise, the problems that come during the night, as called “طَوَارِقُ” (*tawariq*).

In addition to this, it means the hunting animal. This because “جَرَحَ يَجْرَحُ” (*jaraha yajrah*): to wound. “الْجَرَا حَ” (*al-jarahah*): the wound which is inflicted by a spear or sword.

Quran has used “الْجَوَارِحُ مُكَلَّبِينَ” (*aljawarihi mokaleen*) for those animals one train for hunting, like dogs (5:45).

“جَرَدَ” (*jarad*), “يَجْرُدُ” (*yajrid*): to peel off.

“جَرَدَا لُجْلُدًا” (*jaradaljild*): that he peeled of the hairs of the skin.

“جَرَدَ زَيْدًا مِنْ ثَوْبِهِ” (*jaradazaid aman soba*): He stripped Zaid of his clothes.

“فَتَجَرَدَ” (*fatajarra*): He got nude.

“الْتَجَرَدَ” (*attajarro*): to get nude, undressed.

“الْجَرَادُ” (*al-jirad*): locust, probably because it shave of the trees and fields from crops. (7:133)

“مَكَانٌ جَرْدٌ” (*makan jarid*): such a place where there grows no grass.

“سَنَةٌ جَارُودٌ” (*sanaha jarod*) is a year of extreme famine.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is to clean of something in such a manner that it becomes clearly visible.

“جَرَزَ” (*jarza*), “يَجْرُزُ” (*yajrozo*), “جَرَزَا” (*jarza*): to eat quickly. To murder, to cut off, to uproot.

The basic meaning of this root is to cut off and to be hasty about it.

“الْجَرُوزُ” (*al-jarozu*): when a heavy eater sits down to eat, and leave nothing behind.

“أَرْضٌ جَرَزٌ” (*arz jorz*): field on which nothing grows, or where all vegetation has been grazed clean.

“الْجَرَزُ” (*al-jaraz*): a year when no vegetation grows.

“الْجَارِزُ” (*al-jariz*): an unfertile woman.

“الْجَرَّازُ” (*al-joraz*): a sharp sword.

The Quran says:

18:8	We turn this soil into unfertile ground	وَأَنَّا لَجَاعِلُونَ مَا عَلَيْهَا صَعِيدًا خُرُورًا
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This could mean that We turn this soil into unfertile ground during the season of harvest and winter. It can also mean that whatever is on earth, We keep deteriorating (the cycle of spring and autumn).

“الْجُرْعَةُ” (*al-jar'a*): a sip of a drink (with all three vowels on J).

Lisaan-al-Arab says that “جُرْعَةٌ” (*jar'a*) is the swallowing of a drink once, while “جُرْعَةٌ” (*jar'a*) is the drink itself that gets swallowed.

“التَّجَرُّعُ” (*al-jarro'o*) is the sipping of a drink in such a manner that it becomes very clear that the person who is drinking, is disliking his drink.

Hence the Quran stated regarding those in the state of *Jahannum* that whatever they get to drink there:

14:17	he will drink it loath fully and will not be able to swallow it	يَسْجُرْجُهُ وَلَا يَكَادُ يُرِيغُهُ
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God Almighty! How demeaning can be the bread that one gets in ignominy and subjugation in this world. It is hard to survive without eating and the food can't even be pushed down the throat!

Muheet's compiler says, the real meaning of this root is to break or cut apart (or to collect).

“وَتَرَّ جَرْعٌ” (*wa tarun jare-un*): the bent of a bow which is so crooked that it gets easily spotted among others. “الْأَجْرُغُ” (*alajra'o*): hard and rocky land.

Ibn Faris says it basically means the decreasing or lessening of anything drinkable.

“جَرَفَ” (*jaraf*), “يَجْرِفُ” (*yajrofo*), “جَرْفًا” (*jarfan*): to take a lot, to take all or a big portion.

“جَرَفَ الطِّينَ” (*jarafat teen*): he scraped the earth.

“الْجَارِفُ” (*al-jaarif*): a destruction that destroys the (good) acts of a nation. It also means the plague or some other epidemic.

“يَلَّ جَرَفٌ” (*sailun juraaf*): the flood which washes away everything.

“الْجُرْفُ وَالْجُرُفُ” (*aljarfo wal juruf*): that land which is situated on the banks of a river and gradually is eaten away by the river or washed away in the flood {*T, R*}.

Surah *At-Tauba* says:

9:109	a bank which is gradually being washed away	شَقَّ الْجُرْفُ
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The real meaning of this root is to cleanse, to take out, to take (water) in the palm of the hand and to cut away, or to usurp the whole thing {*F*}.

“جَرَمَ” (*jaram*) basically means to cut something or to remove something from on top of it and lay it bare {*M*}.

Commonly it is used to cut off or pick a fruit from the tree {*R*}.

“جَرَمَ النَّخْلَ” (*jaramal nakhal*): cut off the date palm or picked its fruit.

“الْجَرْمَةُ” (*al-jirmah*): the men who pick the fruits of the date palms.

“جَرَمَ الشَّاةَ جَرْمًا” (*jarama lushata jarma*): he cut off the sheep's wool {*T*}.

“جَرَمَ اللَّحْمَ عَنِ الْعَظْمِ” (*jaramal laham unil azm*): tore off the flesh from the bone and laid it bare {*M*}.

These examples should make the meaning of the word clear, which is to rob, exploitation, to pick somebody else's fruit for self. To rob off other people's gains and to lay them bare. The perpetrators of these acts are called “مُجْرِمُونَ” (*mujremoon*). On this basis every unpleasant effort, (displeasing earnings) are called “جَرْمٌ” (*jarm*)

“أَجْرَمَ” (*aj-ram*): he became one of the ones with “جَرْمٌ” (*jurm*) {*R*}.

Keep this meaning of the word in mind and consider that when the Quran sends a nation “مُجْرِمُونَ” (*mujremoon*) to *jahannum*, what it means. According to the Quran the worst society is one in which some people exploit others and live a luxurious life on the basis of others' hard earned incomes. Such a society is destined for the state of *jahannum*.

Surah *Al-Qalam* says:

68:35	will We equate the <i>muslemeen</i> with the <i>mujremeen</i>	أَفَنَجْعَلُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ كَالْمُجْرِمِينَ
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It is therefore evident that no *Muslim* can ever be a *mujrim*. Also see heading (J-N-Y).

“لَا جَرَمَ” (*la-jaram*): essentially, of course, without doubt, what is evident or unmasked or naked {T}.

The Quran says:

11:22	without doubt these people will be the losers in the end	لَا جَرَمَ إِنَّهُمْ فِي الْآخِرَةِ هُمُ الْآخِسُونَ
5:2	Do not make a nation incite you	لَا يَجْرِمَنَّكُمْ شَنَاؤُ قَوْمٍ

It means to not make a deal unless they makes you agree to acquire it.

Ibn Faris says “جَرَمَ” (*jaram*): to earn.

J-R-Y ج ر ي

“جَرَى وَجَرَيَانٌ” (*jariun wa jarayan*): means the flow of water, or to flow without any hindrance.

Raghib says “الْجَرَى” (*al-jario*): to walk fast. Hence “جَرَى الْفَرَسُ” (*jaral faras*): the horse ran fast.

The Quran says:

13:2	Each sphere is moving firmly for a destined period (There is no hindrance in its path)	كُلٌّ يَجْرِي لِأَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى
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The feminine is “الْجَارِيَةُ” (*al-jariah*) or “جَارٍ” (*jarin*) or “الْجَارِي” (*al-jari*) which means one which moves, flows, or one who runs fast. The plural of “جَارِيَةُ” (*jariah*) is “جَارِيَاتٌ” (*jariyaat*), and “جَوَارٍ” (*jawarin*).

Quran says:

51:3	The easily gliding ones	الْجَارِيَاتُ يُسْرًا
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The boat which flows or sails in the river is also called “جَارِيَةُ” (*jariah*)

“الْجَارِيَةُ” (*al-jaari*): the moon.

“الْجَوَارِي” (*al-jawariy*): the stars.

“جَارِيَةُ” (*jaariah*): a girl.

“جَرَى إِلَيْهِ الشَّيْءُ” (*jaralahush shaiyi*): means that thing remained for him forever, that is, here is a connotation of perpetuity {T}.

For the perpetuation's meaning, see heading (J-N-N), under which the term “تَجَرَّى مِنَ النَّهَارِ” (*tajri min tahtahal anhaat*) has been explained in the context of heaven.

“الْجَارِي” (*al-jariyo*): counsellor and guarantor {T, M}.

The Quran says:

88:12	there is a flowing stream in it	فِيهَا عَيْنٌ جَارِيَةٌ
42:32	ships in the sea	الْجَوَارِي فِي الْبَحْرِ

“الْجُزْءُ” (*al-juzz*): a part of something.

“أَجْزَاءُ” (*ajza*): the parts (plural) of which a thing comprises of.

“أَجْزَاءُ السَّعْيَةِ” (*ajza us safeena*), “أَجْزَاءُ الدَّوَاءِ” (*ajza ud dawa*): if some things are removed from among many things, they will also be a part of that collection and called a “جُزْءُ” (*juzz*) of that collection {T}.

Surah *Az-Zakhruf* says about the Christians:

43:15	some say that some of God's followers are a part of Him (His sons)	وَجَعَلُوا لَهُ مِنْ عِبَادِهِ جُزْءًا
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This is meant to deny the concept of the ‘Holy Trinity’, which is “One of three and three in One”. This concept divides God into three! Or it is meant to show as false any notion which gives any man a share in God's domain. Jesus being the son of God also comes within the purview of this concept, or the concept that Man is God, as well.

“جَزَعٌ” (*jaz-un*): to tear into pieces or separate

“الْجُزْءُ” (*al-juz*) is a part of something whether it is attached to the whole or not. It is not necessary that to separate a part every individual part of the whole also be cut or broken off. A lot of individuals together may form a part of the whole.

Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

15:44	for everyone (for the humans who will enter <i>jahannum</i>) of the doors, a part has been destined	لِكُلِّ بَابٍ مِنْهُمْ جُزْءٌ مَقْسُومٌ
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This does not mean that the humans have been torn to pieces and their parts have been separated but it means that every group has been separated. This makes the verse of surah *Al-Baqrah* clear in which *Ibrahim* has been told to make familiar very well with four birds

2:260	then leave them separately in the mountains ; then call out to them and they will fly towards you	ثُمَّ اجْعَلْ عَلَى كُلِّ جَبَلٍ مِنْهُمْ جُزْءًا
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The Quran uses the word “جَزَاءُ” (*jazaa*) for the result of one's deeds. See its meaning in heading (J-Z-Y).

“جَزَعٌ” (*jaz-un*) actually means to cut a rope in the middle {R}. Then it began to be used to mean to cut anything or delink it from the whole

“جَزَعَ الْأَرْضَ وَالْوَادِيَّ” (*jaza' al arda wal waadi*): he separated the land from the valley {T}.

“جَزَعُ الْوَادِيَّ” (*jiz-ul waadi*) actually is the place where the valley turns or ends.

“الْجَارِعُ” (*al-jazey*) is that main beam in the ceiling and smaller pieces join it: thus it divides these smaller pieces or the room itself into two parts {R}.

“الْجَزَعُ” (*Al-jaza'o*) is the opposite of “صَبْرٌ” (*sabar*). “صَبْرٌ” (*sabar*): perseverance, to be stable. See heading (*Sd-B-R*). When something is left in the middle, that is, one dissociates himself with it, then it is “الْجَزَعُ” (*aljaza*) that is to lose hope, to be unstable {R}.

Surah *Ibrahim* says:

14:21	whether we lose heart or stay stable	أَجْزَعْنَا أَمْ صَبْرْنَا
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“جَزَاءٌ” (*jaza’oon*), “جَازِيَةٌ” (*jaaziah*): the return for something.
 “جَزَاهُ كَذَابِهِ وَعَلَيْهِ” (*jaza-hu kazaubehi alaih*): he replied to something in such a way that {T}.
 “مُجَازَاةٌ” (*mujazah*): to give return to each other. Ordinarily, it is used to mean a return for bad things while “مُكَافَاةٌ” (*makafa’ah*) is used for good things.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to replace i.e. for one thing to be in another’s place.

This meaning points to a great truth. What is considered to be the result of deeds is actually the ‘natural’ result of that deed, that is, the result replaces the deed. If you put your hand into the fire, it is your act, your hand is burnt and it is very painful, this is the result of your act. The act ended soon but it was replaced by the result. This brings the Quranic concept of reward and punishment (*jaza* and *saza*) to the fore. According to this concept, neither reward comes from somewhere outside, or punishment. You abuse someone, he slaps you, and this punishment is from the outside because the abuse and slap have no connection. But if you eat poison and then die, this is a result of your act. In other words the result replaces the act.

That is why the Quran says:

7:147	acts are in a way their own results (every result replaces the act)	هَلْ يُجْزَوْنَ إِلَّا مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ
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“جَزَى الشَّيْءُ يَجْزِي” (*jazash shaiyu yajzi*): that thing was enough. **Ibn Faris** too, agrees with this meaning.
 “مَا يُجْزِينِي بِذَا النَّوْبِ” (*ma yujzaini haazas saub*): this cloth will not be enough for me.
 “بِذِهِ إِبِلٌ مَجَازِي” (*hazehi iblun majazee*): For me, these camels will be enough for taking up the load {T}.

The Quran says:

2:48	on which day the biggest of men cannot take the load for someone else’s crime (no man can adopt anybody results)	يَوْمًا لَا تَجْزِي نَفْسٌ عَنْ نَفْسٍ شَيْئًا
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Ibn Faris says it means to compensate on behalf of another.

“جِزْيَةٌ” (*jizyah*) is used in 9:29 for the tax that is taken from non-Muslims for their protection. That is, that which is thought to be enough to provide their lives, possessions, honor etc. with protection, and due to which they are to be exempted from taking part in wars. This small tax is taken in return for all the benefits that non-Muslims enjoy in an Islamic state and maintenance of which is the responsibility of the Muslims.

Imam-ur Rahmani has said that “الْجِزْيَةُ” (*jizyah*) is equivalent to “الْعَهْدُ” (*al-ahd*) (pact)
 “الذِّمَّةُ” (*az-zimmah*): responsibility.
 “الْأَمَانُ” (*al-aman*): peace, security
 “الْخِرَاجُ” (*al-khiraj*): tax {M}

Thus it would mean the pact or agreement in which somebody is provided security in exchange for a small tax.

“الْجَسَدُ” (*al-jasad*): means human body. Other bodies which eat and drink are not called “جَسَدٌ” (*jasad*), but the creatures which do not eat or drink but have a mind. According to the Arab’s belief, *djinns* and *malaikas* etc. their bodies too may be called “جَسَدٌ” (*jasad*) {T, R}.

The Quran has however called *Bani Israeel’s* calf as “جَسَدٌ” (*jasada*) in 7:148.

Muheet’s compiler as well as *Ibn Faris* says that it means for something to be consolidated and hard. As such “جَسَدٌ” (*jasad*) is a solid and compound body. The calf made by *Sameri*, was called “جَسَدٌ” (*jasad*) perhaps because it was solid as well as made out of various jewellery and therefore compound. *Kulyaat* or the Key says that “جَسَدٌ” (*jasad*) is actually a colourful body {M}.

Surah Anbia uses the word “جَسَدٌ” (*jasada*) in 21:8 for a human body, but at the same time, it is mentioned that those “جَسَدًا” (*jasadah*) were not such so as not to eat or drink. *Suleman’s* son has also been called “جَسَدًا” (*jasadah*) in 38:33. That is, a piece of flesh, but only “دَابَّةٌ” (*dabbah*) 34:14.

Torah says following about this son (*Ajaam*) of *Suleman*:

“And on the fifth year of Ajaam’s government, it so happened that the Egyptian king Siiq attacked Jerusalem and looted the treasures of God and the King’s house ...during the reign of Salomo, a man named Birbaum had conspired together with an astrologer called Haya against his government. At that time his efforts had failed, but during Ajaam’s time he became very powerful and together with ten leaders of Bani Israeel, he defeated Ajaam. He had the idol house made as against the Jewish place of religion where golden and silver idols were worshipped.” (Salateen 1, Chapter 14 - 11:12).

This son of *Suleman*, who also sat on the throne, has been called *Jasad* i.e. only a compound of flesh, in order to point to his incapability (38:34). This was known by *Suleman* during his lifetime and he had prayed to God to keep the kingdom safe.

“جَسٌ” (*jass*) basically means to touch, and to find out by touching the pulse whether one is healthy or sick. It is closer to “حَسٌ” (*hus*) which means to find out about the things which one can feel. “الْجَسُّ” (*al-jas*): to probe and investigate the internal matters and secrets.

Some say that “تَجَسَّ” (*tajassus*) and “تَجَسَّسَ” (*tahussus*) have the same meaning with the only difference that “تَجَسَّ” (*tajassus*) is to find out for another and “تَجَسَّسَ” (*tahussus*) is for self. Word “جَاسُوسٌ” (*jasos*) meaning spy, comes from this. Some say “تَجَسَّسَ” (*tajassus*): to find out secrets and “تَجَسَّسَ” (*tahussus*): to eavesdrop {T, R}.

“الْجَاسُوسُ” (*al-jasooos*) is a bad confidante and “النَّامُوسُ” (*an-namooos*) and “الْحَاسُوسُ” (*al-hasooos*) is a good confidante.

Quran says:

49:12	don’t investigate hidden things for nothing	لَا تَجَسَّسُوا
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This means don’t try to find out for personal gain or things which he wants to keep hidden and which brook no evil. Don’t waste your precious time in such useless things. These meanings also indicate an element of evil, that is, to do this for a bad purpose is not good. But for governments it is necessary to know internal things about citizens and foreigners. These do not fall into the category which Quran has forbidden.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning of “الْجِسْمُ” (*al-jism*) is for something to collect.

It is used for body (the overall shape), the limbs of the body {*T*}.

“تُعْجِبُكَ أَجْسَامُهُمْ” (*tu'jiboka ajsamohum*) as used in 63:4 means their stature, hulk.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* has used this word for bodily strength in 2:247 where it is said that the army can be commanded by someone who has knowledge as well as bodily strength, as well as others benefit from it.

Note how the Quran has highlighted the importance of bodily strength along with knowledge. Any individual or nation which is weak, its scholarliness cannot be of much benefit to it. In bodily strength, every type of physical force is included. No doubt the aim is to nurture the personality of Man, but at the present level of existence, it is not possible without nurturing the body. Bodily strength is as essential as for the eggshell to be intact for the egg to be formulated. Within the Quranic system, body and personality, both find ways to develop.

“جَعَلَ” (*ja'al*): means a lot of things, and according to *Raghib*, it can be used for a lot of things. Also in comparison to “فَعَلَ” (*fa'al*) (he did) and “صَنَعَ” (*sana'*) (he made) etc. “جَعَلَ” (*ja'al*) has much broader meaning {*T, R*}:

Muheet says it means to exchange as well as to name something (2:143), and to believe (15:96).

Although all these have the connotations “to do” or “to make” but these examples make the usage of the root clear.

For example the Quran says:

19:30	He made me a Nabi (Messenger)	وَجَعَلَنِي نَبِيًّا
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Here it means quite different than manufacture or create. But:

6:1	He created darkness and light	جَعَلَ الظُّلُمَاتِ وَالنُّورَ
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Here “جَعَلَ” (*ja'al*): to invent and create.

Similarly:

21:30	and we created every living thing from water	وَجَعَلْنَا مِنَ الْمَاءِ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ حَيٍّ
16:78	God made eyes, ears and heart (mind) for you	وَجَعَلَ لَكُمُ السَّمْعَ وَالْأَبْصَارَ وَالْأَفْئِدَةَ
15:74	we exchanged its lower part with its upper part.	جَعَلْنَا غَالِيَهَا سَافِلَهَا

Here too, “جَعَلَ” (*ja'al*): the same. For “فِي” (*fi*) to come after it, makes it mean for putting one thing into another:

2:19	they put their fingers into their ears	يَجْعَلُونَ أَصَابِعَهُمْ فِي آذَانِهِمْ
57:27	we created softness and sympathy in the hearts of those who obeyed that Messenger (Jesus)	وَجَعَلْنَا فِي قُلُوبِ الَّذِينَ اتَّبَعُوهُ رَأْفَةً وَرَحْمَةً

Wherever this word appears in Quran its meaning will be determined according to the context. It will not have the same meaning everywhere, because as said above, this word is like the English phrase ‘to make’ and has many meanings. For the other meanings of “جَعَلَ” (*ja'al*).

“الْجَفْنُ” (*al-jafn*): eyebrow, both upper and lower, sheath for a sword.

“الْجَفْنَةُ” (*al-jafna*): small well, big bowl for eating. Its plural is “جَفَانٌ” (*jifaan*) as in (34:13). It is said in this verse that the people of the mountainous areas (*djinn*), whom *Suleman* had put to work for him, used to make, beside other things, big lagans.

Ibn Faris says this word means anything that encompasses some other thing, that is, takes it within its fold.

“جَفَا” (*jafa*), “جَفَاءَ” (*jafa'a*), “تَجَافَى” (*tajafa*): he failed to stay in his place, like the saddle which doesn't stay on the horse's back.

“إِجْتَفَيْتُهُ” (*ijtafaituhu*): I removed him from his place.

“جَفَامَالَهُ” (*jafa maalahu*): he was separated from his camels.

“الْجَفَاءُ” (*al-jufaa*): the dirt of the (cooking) which comes out and falls when the vessel boils.

“أَجْفَتِ الْقِدْرُ رَبَدًا” (*ajfatil qadrozabadha*): the vessel threw out its boil {T} (whatever was boiling). As such this came to mean the dirt etc. That remained in both corners of the valley, or every useless thing {T}.

Surah *Ar-Raad* says:

13:17	so the foam goes totally waste	فَأَمَّا الرِّبْدُ فَيَذْهَبُ جُفَاءً
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It is from this concept that “جَفَتِ الْأَرْضُ وَاجْفَتْ” (*jafatil ardo wa ajfat*): the land became without any good, i.e. turned useless {T}.

In the Quran, about the *Momineen* it is said:

32:16	their sides leave the beds (to complete Allah's program, they lose their sleep or have very little sleep.)	تَتَخَالَفِي جُؤْبُهُمْ عَنِ الْمَضَاجِعِ
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“جَلَبَهُ” (*jalabah*), “يَجْلِبُهُ” (*yajlibohu*): he drove him from one place to another {T, M, R}.

It is used to take the goods from one place to another for trading {M}.

“الْجَلَبُ” (*al-jalab*): those who drive goats or camels from one place to another for selling. The goats and camels are called “جَلَبٌ” (*jalab*) as well.

“عَبْدٌ جَلِيبٌ” (*abdun jaleeb*): a slave who has been brought from another city, the vagaries of the weather, pangs of hunger or hard work. This has led to “الْجَلْبُ” (*al-jalb*) meaning to oppress somebody and to be harsh.

“جَلَبَ عَلَيْهِ” (*jalaba alaih*): he oppressed him.

“أَجْلَبَ الْقَوْمُ عَلَيْهِ” (*ajlabal qaumo alaih*): the nation gathered against him.

“أَجْلَبَ الْقَوْمُ” (*ajlabal qaum*): people from all sides gathered for battle.

Quran has used it in this meaning:

17:64	bring all your armies against them (storm them)	وَأَجْلِبْ عَلَيْهِمْ
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Ibn Faris says the other basic meaning of this word is something which covers another.

This way “الْجِلْبَابُ” (*al-jilbaab*) is a cloth which is bigger than a scarf but smaller than a shawl with which women cover their heads and breasts with {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

33:59	to cover themselves with their shawls	يُذِنْنَ عَلَيْهِنُ مِنْ جِلْبَابٍ
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That too was called “جِلْبَابُ” (*jilbaab*). By such, broad cloth was meant peace and tranquillity as a proverb.

J-L-D

ج ل د

“أَجْلَدُ” (*al-jild*), “جِلْدُ” (*jald*): the skin of every living thing (16:80). The plurals are “جُلُودُ” (*julud*) or “أَجْلَادُ” (*ajlaad*).

“أَجْلَدُ” (*il-jild*) also allegorically means the penis.

“أَجْلَادُ الْإِنْسَانِ” (*ajlaadul insaan*): the body and the whole human skeleton.

Ibn Faris says it means strength and hardness (toughness):

“فُلَانٌ عَظِيمُ الْأَجْلَادِ” (*falanoon azeemul ajlaad*): he has strong limbs and body.

“يَا مَا شَبَّهَ أَجْلَادُهُ بِأَجْلَادِ أَبِيهِ” (*yama ashbaha wa ajlaadohu bi ajlaadey aabeeh*): his body and features, face, and built is so much like his father {*T, M, R*}.

It also means stuffed skin of a baby camel which is put before a female camel prior to milking her.

“أَجْلَدُ” (*al-jalad*): intensity and strength, stability and toughness.

The compiler of Muheet says it means the sky, celestial spheres, and water which has fallen from above and frozen on earth.

Raghib says that just as “قُلُوبُ” (*qulub*) it means individuals, “جُلُودُ” (*julud*) may mean bodies {*T, R*}.

“الْمُجْلَدُ” (*al-mujlad*): the piece of leather which the womenfolk hit their faces with while grieving.

“جَلَدَ يَجْلِدُ” (*jalad yajlid*): to strike with a whip (24:2) {*T, M, R*}.

Raghib says it means

- To hit with leather
- To hit the skin

“جَلَدَهُ عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*jalada alil amr*): forced him to {*T, M, R*}.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:56	Their <i>julud</i> (skins) wear out, we will give them other skins	كُلَّمَا نَضِجَتْ جُلُودُهُمْ بَدَّلْنَاهُمْ جُلُودًا غَيْرَهَا لِيَذُوقُوا الْعَذَابَ
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This means they will feel the punishment continuously. When after facing the ordeal once they will rise again, and face defeat and ignominy again. Facing this continuously, their strength and toughness will be shattered. From the battle of Badr to the victory in Mecca, they (the opponents) faced continuous defeats and at last the toughness of the opponents ended.

In Surah Ha Miim, “سمع و بصر” (*sahahada*) has been mentioned with “جُلُودُ” (*julud*) 41:20-22. That is, the hearing of the *mujrameen*, along with their sight and acts will testify against them. They will testify against themselves. Every act has an effect on the human personality, therefore the basic witness to every human act is the human personality itself, no matter what excuses the intellect presents

75:14 75:15	Man is proof against his own personality, no matter with how many excuses he defends himself.	بَلِ الْإِنْسَانُ عَلَى نَفْسِهِ بَصِيرَةٌ - وَلَوْ أَلْفَى مَعَاذَ يَرُهُ
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This is the evidence of sight, hearing and “جلود” (*julud*). The time that the results are known is pretty difficult when man’s most secret act cannot remain hidden, not even a passing thought.

“جَلَسَ” (*jalas*), “يَجْلِسُ” (*yajlis*), “جُلُوساً” (*julusa*), “مَجْلِساً” (*majlisa*): to sit
 “جُلُوسٌ” (*julus*): a man who was in lying down position but sits up, while
 “قُعُودٌ” (*qu'ood*): a man who is standing up but then sits down.
 “الْجَلْسُ” (*al-jals*): hard and high ground which is its basic meaning. It is used for sitting because a man puts his backside on hard ground {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is to be higher, and since a man who sits up from lying down, does becomes higher (compared to when he is lying down). This word is thus used for him.

Quran uses the word “مَجَالِسُ” (*majalis*) in 58:11. This means the places where people sit in a gathering.

“جَلَّ الرَّجُلُ يَجْلُ جَلَالَةً وَجَلَالاً” (*jallar rujulo yajullo jalalatum wa jalalah*): to be old.
 “جَلِيلٌ” (*jaleel*): to be very distinguished.
 “جَلَّ الشَّيْءُ” (*jallush shaiyi*): the larger part of a thing
 “الْجَلِيُّ” (*al-ujalla*): great thing.
 “الْجُلُّ” (*al-julla*): the cloth which is put on for protection on a four legged animal.
 “الْجَلِيلُ” (*al-jaleel*): big man or camel, as against “نَقِيقٌ” (*daqeeq*) which means a goat {*T, R*}

The real meaning, according to *Muheet*, is to be round and high.

Raghib says that “جلال” (*jalaal*) has more of the meaning of an expert, than a great man.

The Quran says about God:

55:27	One who has greatness and <i>jalaal</i> (greatness).	ذُو الْجَلَالِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ
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For the meaning of “إِكْرَامٌ” (*ikraam*), see heading (K-R-M).

“الْجَلَاءُ” (*al-jala'u*): to disperse, to separate, to exile. (56:3)
 “جَلَا فَلَاناً الْأَمْرُ” (*jala fulanal amr*): he opened the matter before him, made it evident, clear.

Ibn Faris says the above mentioned are its basic meaning.

Quran says:

91:3	(the period), when it pierces the darkness and makes everything prominent and clear	وَالنَّهَارِ إِذَا تَجَلَّى
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“الْجَلِيُّ” (*al-jaliyo*): distinct event, opposite of secret.
 “الْجَلَاءُ” (*al-jala'o*): distinct event.
 “الْجُلُوءُ” (*al-jilwah*): anything which the husband gives his wife on the wedding night {*T*}.

7:143	when his Sustainer disclosed himself on the mount	فَلَمَّا تَخَلَّى رُؤْيَاهُ لِلْجَبَلِ
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“جَلُوءٌ” (*jalwu*) actually means to open up {*R*}.

”جَمَحَ الْفَرَسُ“ (*jamahal faras*): the running of a horse with such a rage that its rider no longer is in control, this running a horse with his head high {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

9:57	they are running away uncontrollably (defying the law of God)	وَهُمْ يَجْمَحُونَ
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”الْجَمَّاحُ“ (*al-jumma*): the defeated whom it is impossible to bring back to the battle field.

”جَمَحَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ مِنْ زَوْجِهَا“ (*jama-atil mar-ato min zaujeha*): a woman who is angry with her husband and leaves home for her mother's without being divorced.

”جُمَيْحُ“ (*jumeeh*): a man's phallus

”الْجَمُوحُ“ (*al-jumuh*): a man who follows his emotions and it is difficult to prevent him from doing so {*T, M, R*}

Ibn Faris says it means for a thing to move ahead with force and overwhelming ness. Later, it came to mean run away or to run.

”جَمَدَ الْمَاءُ“ (*jamadak ma'oo*): the water froze, became stagnant.

”الْجَمْدُ“ (*al-jamd*): ice, frozen water.

”الْجَمَادُ“ (*al-jamaad*): a slow moving camel which has stopped giving milk.

”جَمَادَةُ الْكَفِّ“ (*jamadul kaff*): a miser.

”عَيْنُ جَمُودٍ“ (*ainun jamood*): the eye which does not shed tears {*T*}.

”الْجَمَادُ“ (*al-jamad*): land, anything which does not grow, which is inorganic.

”جَمَادَى الْأُولَى“ (*jamadal awla*) and ”جَمَادَى الْآخِرَةِ“ (*jamadil akhirah*): the two months after *Rabi-us Saani*.

At that time these months were so named, because they used to fall during heavy winter. Now since one goes by the moon it is not necessary for each month, each year to fall in this season {*T*}.

Quran says about the *jibbaal* (the leaders of the nation or elite):

27:88	you think they are frozen	تَحْسِبُهَا جَامِدَةً
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”الْجَمْعُ“ (*al-jam'o*): to gather different tribes together.

Raghib says it means to bring things closer together. It also means red coloured glue. It also means a group of people.

”الْجَمِيعُ“ (*al-jami'o*): army, crowd, or tribe.

”الْجُمَاغُ“ (*al-jumma*): anything with its elements mixed with each other, consolidated, the people of different tribes who have gathered together. It also means the place where the roots of anything converge.

”جُمُعُ الْكَفِّ“ (*jum ul-kuff*): closed fist {*T*}.

”أَجْمَعُ“ (*aj-maa*) (masculine),

”جَمَعَاءُ“ (*jam'aa*) (feminine),

”أَجْمَعُونَ“ (*ajma'oon*) (masculine plural),

”جُمُعُ“ (*juma'un*): (plural feminine).

These words appear only for stressing something, i.e. when we say ”أَجْمَعُونَ“ (*ajma'oon*), we would not mean everybody, the meaning would be the majority.

”أَجْمَعْتُ الْأَمْرَ“ (*ajma'tul amr*): I decided firmly to do it (10:71).

Raghib says it connotes to decide on something after deliberating over it.

”أَمْرٌ جَامِعٌ“ (*amrey jamey*): wonderful work for which people will gather.

“يَوْمَ الْجُمُعَةِ” (*yaumul jumu’ati*): before the advent of Islam, the Quresh (tribe) used to gather a day every week at *Darun Nidow* (their national parliament) near the *Darun Qusi*, and called that day “يَوْمَ الْعُرُوبَةِ” (*yaumul urubah*).

Ka’ab bin Lawi named that day “يَوْمَ الْجُمُعَةِ” (*yaumul jumuaa*). As such he began to be called “الْمُجَمَّعُ” (*al-jamioh*) which was the nickname of *Qussi bin Kalaab* who had built the *Darun Nidow {M}*. This makes the meaning of the word “جمعة” (*jumuaa*) (Friday) clear. It means to gather for consultation.

Quran says the group of Momineen are wont to:

42:38	they establish the system of salaah and they decide their affairs by mutual consultation	أَقَامُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَأَمْرُهُمْ شُورَى بَيْنَهُمْ
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They bow before God in the prayer gatherings is the physical manifestation that we have gathered for obeying God’s order and the purpose of our consultation too is similar.

Muheet says “الْجُمُعَةُ” (*al-jumah*) is derived from “اجْتَمَعَ” (*ijtemah*) which means gathering just as “الْفُرْقَةُ” (*al-furqah*) has been derived from “افترق” (*ifteraaq*).

Quran uses “الْجُمُعَةُ” (*jami’un*) against “اِسْتَأْتَاتَ” (*astatah*) in 24:61. That is, gathering as against separately or individually.

Surah *An-Nisa* uses “جَمِيعًا” (*jami’un*) as against “تُبَاتٍ” (*subaat*) in 4:71 which means in the shape of a whole army. For “تُبَاتٍ” (*subaat’s*) meaning see heading (Th-B-Y).

The word “اجْمَعِينَ” (*ajma-een*) has been used by the Quran several times, as in 2:161. As said before it is used to stress not to mean that nobody is left out.

J-M-L

ج م ل

“الْجَمَلُ” (*al-jamul*), “الْجَمَلُ” (*al-jaml*): male camel. Plural is “جَمَالُهُ” (*jimalah*) as used in 77:33
“جَمَالٌ” (*jamal*): beauty too as used in 16:6 {T}:

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings are
- to gather and to be higher in creation
- beauty.

For the Arabs, camel has most “جَمَلٌ” (*jamal*), meaning loftiness and beauty. Their own grandeur was due to (having) these camels.

“جَمِيلٌ” (*jamel*): beautiful manner, good thing {T}.

“فَصْبَرٌ جَمِيلٌ” (*fasbarun jameel*): to bear loss in a good manner and to stay stable (12:18).

“الْجَمْلُ” (*al-jummal*), “الْجَمْلُ” (*al-juml*), “الْجَمْلُ” (*al-jumalo*), “الْجَمْلُ” (*al-jamal*): thick rope on a boat {T, R}

Quran says:

7:40	till the ship’s rope passes through the eye of the needle (which is an impossibility)	حَتَّى يَلِجَ الْجَمَلُ فِي سَمِّ الْخِيَاطِ
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“الْجُمْلَةُ” (*al-jumlah*): collection of things {T, R}.

“الْمُجْمَلُ” (*al-mujmal*): the collection of many things, that is, things which have not been separately detailed {T, R}.

Quran says:

25:32	all at once	جُمْلَةً وَاحِدَةً
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For “مجمل” (*mujmal*) and “مفصل” (*mufasssal*) see heading (F-Sd-L).

“الْجَمُّ” (*al-jumm*): the abundance of everything.
 “مَالٌ جَمٌّ” (*maalun jumm*): much wealth
 “جُمْتُ الْمَاءِ” (*jummatul ma'a*): the place for lot of water to collect {T}.

Ibn Faris has said that its basic meanings are abundance and gathering.

“جَمَّتِ الْبِئْرُ” (*jammatil bey'ro*): the water returned to the well after being taken out and collected in abundance (replenished in abundance).

“الْجَمُّ” (*al-jamam*): whatever is above the glass, full to the brim {T}.

“الْجَمَامَةُ” (*al-jamama*): comfort, contentment.

“جَمَاعٌ غَفِيرٌ” (*jamman ghafeera*): all of them, a big number of people which includes the big and the small, the elite and the commoners.

Quran says:

89:20	you love wealth dearly, and want it to come towards you as water collects in a ditch	وَتُحِبُّونَ الْمَالَ حُبًّا جَمًّا
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This is what happens in capitalism. Wealth gets concentrated in a few hands. The Quran has come in order to erase such a system.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings are of avoidance, and distance.

Zajaj says that it means the path to which he invited me.

“الْجُنُبُ” (*al-junb*): direction, towards, side {T, R}. Its plural is “جُنُوبٌ” (*junub*) as in 3:190.

“الصَّاحِبُ بِالْجُنُبِ” (*as-sahibo bil janb*): companion, friend (4:36)

“الْأَجْرِيُّ” (*al-jaaril junb*): *Kitabul Ashqaaq* says it means “الْغَرِيبُ” (*al-ghareeb*) or a stranger.

The Quran says:

39:56	the shortcomings committed in following Allah's orders	مَا فَرَّطْتُ فِي جُنُبِ اللَّهِ
5:6	the state of fornication	وَأَنْ كُنْتُمْ جُنُبًا

“جَنْبُهُ” (*janbah*): to stay separate from the others.

“جُنْبُهُ” (*junabah*): the thing which one keeps away from {Lane}

“جَنْبُهُ” (*janabah*), “جَانِبُهُ” (*janabhu*): moved him away.

“جَنْبُهُ” (*jannabahu*), “أَجْنَبَهُ” (*ajnabah*): removed him.

“رَجُلٌ جَنْبٌ” (*rajolin janib*): stranger etc. and a person who due to miserliness stays away from the usual life so that he won't have to be someone's host.

“سَيَجْنِبُهَا” (*saijannoboha*) as in 92:72, “يَتَجَنَّبُهَا” (*yatajannoboha*) as in 87:11, “إِجْتَنَّبَ” (*ijtanab*) as in 39:17.

All these above words have the same connotation, that is, to stay away or keep away.

“جَانِبُ الْبَرِّ” (*janibul burr*) as in 17:68 means piece of dry land

“الْجَنَابُ” (*al-janab*): open ground in front of one's house {T}.

It also means some place where one alights or stays {M}.

Surah *Al-Qasas* says when his mother put the child into a box and pushed him out into the river, she told her daughter, *Moosa's* sister to follow the trunk down the river. She kept him in sight and the Pharaoh's people could not feel that she is following him:

28:11	and she kept looking at him like a stranger so that the people couldn't understand that she is in fact looking for him	فَبَصُرَتْ بِهِ عَنْ جُنُبٍ وَهُمْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ
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“الْجَنَاحُ” (*al-jinah*), with plural “الْجَنَاحَاتُ” (*amjinhah*): hand, arm, bird’s wing, armpit, side.
 “أَنَا فِي جَنَاحِهِ” (*ana fi jinahihi*): I am in his shadow and protection {T}

Protection of the sort like when a hen takes the chicks under her wings in danger.
 “جَنَحَ إِلَيْهِ” (*janah ilaihi*): he was attracted to him, leaned towards him.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to lean. This led to its meaning leaning towards sin {T}.
 Muheet contends that this word is the Arabised form of sin, and is also used to mean harm.

When the Messenger was told to move away from opponents and organize his own group, he was told:

15:88	lower your shoulder for people of your group (gather them under your wings like a hen takes her new born chicks under its wings)	كِهِ وَأَخْفِضْ جَنَاحَكَ لِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ
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In surah *Al-Qasas*, *Moosa* has been told that in the struggle against the Pharaoh not to lose heart, but to keep himself together:

28:32	at times of fear, don't panic, keep your wits about you (protect the people of your party, or organize them)	وَأَضْمِمْ إِلَيْكَ جَنَاحَكَ مِنَ الرَّهْبِ
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All these things could be meant.

In surah *Bani Israeel*, regarding the upkeep and protection of parents, it is said:

17:24	lower your shoulder to them in kindness and sympathy	وَأَخْفِضْ لَهُمَا جَنَاحَ الذِّلِّ مِنَ الرَّحْمَةِ
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Look after them with great compassion because they have become (old and) dependent.

Surah *Al-Faatir* says “أُولَىٰ أَجْنَحٍ” (*ooli ajneha*) about the *malaikah* in 35:1, where the literal meanings are with wings, because wings are used for flying. So figuratively it would mean multidimensional cosmic forces.

To mean sin or harm, the word “جُنَاحٌ” (*junnah*) has been used at several places:

2:158	there is no harm in moving between these mounts (<i>Safaa, Marwah</i>)	لَا جُنَاحَ عَلَيْهِ أَنْ يَطَّوَّفَ بِهِمَا
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Ibn Faris has said its second basic meaning is 'excess'.

“الْجُنْدُ” (*al-janad*): hard land, stones which look like earth.
 “جُنْدٌ” (*jund*): people who gather or things which are collected.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings of this word are to gather together or help.

“الْجُنْدُ” (*al-jund*): army, because of its harshness. Plural is “جُنُودٌ” (*junud*), and every soldier a “جُنْدٌ” (*jund*).

Surah *Maryam* mention “أَضْعَفُ جُنْدًا” (*az-afu junda*) in 19:75, which means those whose friends and companions, party or group is weak.

Surah *Al-Fatah* says:

48:4	The armies of the skies and the earth are for Allah	أَضْعَفُ جُنْدًا
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This refers to all the forces of the universe.

Muheet says this means a particular kind of creature as well.

Surah *Al-Brooj* says:

85:17	Have you heard about the armies? (tales about those with big armies)	هَلْ أَتَاكَ حَدِيثُ الْجُنُودِ
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(The next verse then discusses the Pharaoh and the *Samood* people).

J-N-F

ج ن ف

“الْجَنَفُ” (*al-janaf*): to lean on one side, partiality, or predilection. This is used for straying from the path of justice.

“تَجَافَى عَنْ طَرِيقَةٍ” (*tajanafa un tareeqih*): moved to one side from his path {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

2:182	Whoever fears that the maker of the will shall be partial to someone. (He will not be fair and favour one more than the other)	فَمَنْ خَافَ مِنْ مُوصِيٍ جَنَفًا
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Note that “مُجْنِفٌ” (*mujnif*) is someone who is not fair and favours someone {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Ma'ida* says:

5:3	who would not favour sin	عَمِيرٌ مُتَجَانِفٌ لِإِيمٍ
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J-N-N

ج ن ن

“جُنٌّ” (*junn*) basically means to hide. *Raghib* says “جُنٌّ” (*junn*): to hide something from one perspective.

6:77	when the darkness of the night hid it, he saw a star	فَلَمَّا جَنَّ عَلَيْهِ اللَّيْلُ رَأَى كَوْكَبًا
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As it is, “قَدْ جَنَّ عَنْكَ” (*qad junnaa anka*) is said for anything which is hidden from your view.

“جَنٌّ” (*janan*): a grave, because it hides the corpse or a dead body. It means the dead body and also the shroud as well.

“جَنِينَ جَمْعُ اجْنَةٍ” (*janeen*) is the plural as used in 53:32, and means a foetus

“جَنَّةٌ” (*junnah*) is a weapon one uses for defence, any veil or hiding place.

“جَنَّةٌ” (*junnah*) and “مِجَنَّةٌ” (*mijinnah*) also means shield {*T, M*}.

58:16	means there is no secret about it	لَا جَنٍّ بَلَدًا الْأَمْرِ
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“جَنَّةٌ” (*jinnah*) also means madness, as used in 23:25

Actually among the Arabs, it is thought that “مَجْنُونٌ” (*majnnon*) is one whom a “جِنٌّ” (*jinn*) has possessed. During the superstitious era, all those forces which man could not see with the naked eye nor comprehend attained the stature of gods and goddesses. These, due to their being oblivious to the eyes, were called “جِنٌّ” (*jinn*).

They used to call even the angels for “جِنٌّ” (*jinn*), although they worshipped them as well.

Raghib says “الْجِنُّ” (*al-jinn*) is used in two ways. One is when you say “جِنٌّ” (*jinna*), which even includes angles, and secondly “جِنٌّ” (*jinna*) are the hidden forces (spirits), with the difference that the good ones are called *farishta* (angel), and the bad ones are known as the *shayateen* (the devils) {*T, R*}.

Those with good and bad both types are called “جِنٌّ” (*jinn*). As such at several places in the Quran where worship by Arabs during the dark years is mentioned, the word “جِنَّةٌ” (*jinna*): indeed angels, as in 37:158 etc. {*T, R*}.

Our earth was a big ball of fire initially and it took millions of years to cool down and be habitable. The Quran says that before Man, the creatures which lived on this earth had the capacity to bear intense heat. Thereafter they became extinct and got replaced by the humans. See heading **(Kh-L-F)**.

Since those creatures are now extinct, Quran has said:

15:27	before Man We had created creatures from hot air, those creatures are not before you	وَالْجَانَّ خَلَقْنَاهُ مِنْ قَبْلُ مِنْ نَارِ السُّمُومِ
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This can also mean that the things of the universe before coming into material form were in the state of hidden energy and are today in latent form.

Because of it being oblivious to the eyes, and due to its rebellious nature, **Iblees** is also said to be among the **jinn**. See heading **(B-L-S)**, and **(Sh-Te-N)**.

At several places in the Quran, the words “جِنٌّ” (**jinn**) and “أَنْسٌ” (**ins**) have come together in the same sentence. In the heading (A-N-S) we have already said “أَنْسٌ” (**ins**) among the Arabs meant the tribes that settled permanently at one place, and “جِنٌّ” (**jinn**) were the tribes which roamed from place to place and were thus not seen by many. They are also called Nomadic tribes. Even today, such tribes move about jungles and deserts away from the usual population, but due to the information explosion many things have become common between them and the general population. Therefore there is no basic enmity between them, but in the times when the information explosion had not taken place, the lives of these Nomadic tribes and the usual population differed so much in their culture and ways of living that they seemed to be from two different worlds. There were many such tribes among the Arabs. They were called **baddu** or **airaab**. Since Quranic message was for both, therefore **jinn** and **ins** both are addressed.

Upon deliberation on this, it becomes clear that by “جِنٌّ” (**jinn**), it was also meant the humans or “أَنْسٌ” (**ins**), or those wild tribes who lived in the jungles or the deserts.

As in surah **An-Anaam**:

7:131	You group of jinn s and ins , did not our messengers come to you?	يُعْشِرَ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ أَمْ يَأْتِيَكُمُ رُسُلٌ مِنْكُمْ
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The Quran has not mentioned a Messenger who was a **jinn**, and this is further explained in surah **Al-Airaaf** that Messengers were sent from the human race (7:35).

In surah **jinn** and surah **Ahqaaf**, it is said that a group of **jinn**s came to the Messenger and listened to the Quran (its recital). See 46:29 and 72:1. This also proves that **jinn**s too had men as Messengers. These very verses make it clear that the **jinn**s which came to the Messenger for listening to the Quran were humans as well. They were from the wild tribes of Christians, Jews and the **Mushriks** (those who worshipped more than one god).

Surah **Bani Israeel** has that, if the **jinn**s and the humans get together, even then they cannot bring forth something like the Quran.

Surah **Al-Anaam** says that the rebellious among the **ins** and **jinn**s used to oppose the Quran (6:113).

Surah **Al-Airaaf** says that the majority of the **jinn**s and **ins** do not use their intellect and therefore they are **jahan-namees** (will go to **jahannum**) (7:179).

Surah **As-Sajda** says that the dwellers of **Jahannum** will say that they were misled by many among the **jinn** and **ins** (41:29).

Surah **Al-Anaam** says the **ins** (the humans) will say that they used to benefit from the **jinn**s and the **jinn**s will say that they benefited from the **ins** (6:149).

Surah *An-Namal* says that **Suleman** had armies of *ins* and *jinns* (27:17).

Surah *Saba* says about these *jinns* that they used to make statues, used to make lagans i.e. watches of sorts and big cooking pots (34:13). They were kept in chains (38:37-38).

The Torah says that **Suleman** (Solomon) asked the Saur king for men from the *Saiduni* nation for cutting wood from the jungle. As such these people and the “جَبَلِيَّةٌ” (*jibleem*) i.e. mountain tribes, used to cut wood and make structures for **Suleman**. Besides this, **Suleman** had employed 70.000 men from the mountain and jungle tribes of Palestine as labourers, and 10.000 men for cutting wood and making structures.

These explanations show that by *jinn* and *ins*, the Quran means the civilized people and the wild men of the tribes who lived in the deserts and jungles. For more details see my book “*Iblees and Adam*”.

“الْجَانُّ” (*al-jann*): a yellow coloured snake with black eyes as used in 27:10 {T}.

Ibn Faris says that it is used as such due to its connotation to “جَانُّ” (*jann*)

“الْجِنُّ مِنَ النَّبْتِ” (*al-jinni minal nabti*): flowers and buds.

“جُنَّتِ الْأَرْضُ” (*jannatil ard*): grass grew on the land and was pleasing to the eye {T}.

“جَنَّ النَّبَاتُ” (*jan nun nabaat*): the plants grew tall and intertwined.

“نَخْلَةٌ مَجْنُونَةٌ” (*nakhlatun majnoonah*): very tall date palm {T}.

“جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*) is an orchard of dates and grapes. If any orchard contains trees of some other fruits than these, it is called “حَدِيقَةٌ” (*hadeeqah*), not “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*) {T}.

Raghib says “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*) is any garden in which one does not find bare land due to the (abundance) of trees.

The Quran has used the term “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*) in a very comprehensive manner. If the Quranic system is followed, it creates a society which is blissful or “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*), and after death, the blissful results are called “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*) as well. Those who act according to the Quran, the Momineen, get a heavenly society in this life.

Its details are given at different places in the Quran, but if the whole thing is to be understood in short, then one must concentrate on the verse which concerns Adam's tale and which says:

2:35	eat as you want from where you want here, but don't go near that <i>shajara</i>	وَكُلَا مِنْهَا رَغَدًا حَيْثُ شِئْتُمَا وَلَا تَقْرَبَا هَذِهِ الشَّجَرَةَ
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For “شجر” (*shajara*) see heading (Sh-J-R). In short “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*) is that society which has all the comforts of life in abundance, not only food, but dresses as well, as houses etc. That is, all the basic necessities of life. But all these comforts are to be utilized as God has directed. If this is done, then that society will be evergreen (20:118-119).

That is why this has been called:

2:25	The orchard will always have a stream flowing below it	جَرَى مِنْ تَحْتِهَا الْأَنْهَارُ
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The Quran has further explained:

13:35	its fruits and other facilities will always be available	أَكْلُهَا دَائِمٌ وَظِلُّهَا
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Regarding the results of good deeds after death, they have been called “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*) as well, but along with it, it has also been mentioned:

32:17	that result which God has saved of good deeds, that cannot come within human comprehension	فَلَا تَعْلَمُ نَفْسٌ مَأْخُذِي هُمْ مِنْ قُرَّةِ أَعْيُنٍ
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We cannot have any idea about that life. That is why, despite giving so much in detail about the “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*), the Quran has said that all this is only allegorical (13:35).

But we can have a “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*) on this earth as well, provided that we build a society on the lines mentioned by the Quran. Such a society has all the happiness for blissful existence, externally and internally, but we cannot understand the Heaven after death because our consciousness cannot go beyond material things. It will suffice to understand that here we get not only physical comforts but our personality is developed as well. This makes human personality prepared to proceed to the next level and eventually to our ultimate destiny. This sort of personality reaches the stage which is called “جَنَّةٌ” (*jannah*). That is not the last stage in our lives, but the stage to move onwards, because ‘His light will proceed before us’ (57:12). As against this, those whose personality’s development would have stopped, those who are unable to proceed ahead, they will dwell in *jahannum*. (See headings *Jahannam* and J-H-M). However, after death, Heaven or Hell, are not places as such, but the feelings of man’s personality whose reality is beyond our comprehension. We should all try to change the Hell in this world (which we are all living in) into a Heaven. This can only be done through the Quranic system of living.

J-N-Y

ج ن ی

“جَنَى الثَّمَرَةَ يَجْنِيهَا” (*janas samarata yajneeha*): he picked the fruit from the tree. These are its basic meaning {*Ibn Faris*}.

“فَهُوَ جَانٍ” (*fahuwa jaanin*): he is about to pick the fruit.

“الْجَنَى” (*al-janah*): fresh and solid date.

“أَجْنَى الشَّجَرِ” (*ajnash shajar*): the fruits of the tree have become ripe enough to be picked.

“تَمَرٌ جَنِيٌّ” (*samarun jani’un*): fresh fruit which has just been picked {R, T}.

Surah Maryam says “رُطْبًا جَنِيًّا” (*rutaban janiya*) in 19:25. Here it has been used to indicate fresh dates, while surah Rahman says “جَنَّا” (*janaa*) in 55:54 to mean fruits. It also means to pick somebody else’s fruit is as a crime. From this came “الْجَنَایَةُ” (*al-jinayah*) which is a punishable crime.

“جَانٍ” (*jaanin*): crime.

“جَانَى عَلَيْهِ مُجَانَاةً” (*jana alaihi mujanah*): he lodged a case of crime against him {T}. When a man can commit a crime simply by picking someone else’s fruit, then those who usurp the fruits of others’ labor are criminals as well. In this reference, see heading (J-R-M).

J-He-D

ج ه د

“الْجَهْدُ” (*al-jahdo*): *Ibn Abeer* says that it means pain and hard labor, and to take some work to its extreme.

“جَهْدٌ” (*johd*): vastness and strength, but some say that “جَهْدٌ” (*jahd*) and “جُهْدٌ” (*johd*) both mean vastness and strength.

“جَهْدٌ” (*jahd*): hard labor. In the Quran, “جُهْدٌ” (*johd*) has also come to mean hard labor (9:79).

Ibn Faris says this is the word’s basic meaning.

“جَهَادٌ” (*jehad*): to spend all your energies to the full in order to achieve some goal, not to leave any stone unturned for it.

“جَهَادٌ” (*jahad*): hard land without any vegetation.

“أَجْهَدْتُ لَكَ الْأَرْضَ” (*ajhadatun lakal ard*): the earth or land appeared for you {T}.

“الْإِجْتِهَادُ” (*al-ijtehaad*): to spend all your energies for achieving a purpose for which troubles must be taken and hard labor practiced {M}. It has to be troublesome and difficult.

“الْجَاهِدُ” (*al-jahiod*): someone who is awake.

The Quran uses “مُجَاهِدِينَ” (*mujahideen*) as against “قَاعِدِينَ” (*qai-deen*) in 4:95. *Qaideen* are those who remain sitting, he lazy ones. Therefore, the “مُجَاهِدِينَ” (*mujahideens*) are those who struggle, those who do their utmost for the achievement of their goals. They struggle to that extend that they may even have to give their lives for the purpose. According to the Quran, the secret of life is struggle, and strife and action.

As such a “مُؤْمِنٌ” (*momin*) man remains a “مُجَاهِدٌ” (*mujahid*), a struggler though out his life. For the word of war, see heading (Q-T-L).

Surah *An-Nahal* says “جَهْدٌ أَيْمَانِهِمْ” (*jahda aimanihim*) to define a strong promise in 16:38.

“جَهْرٌ” (*jahr*): *Raghib* says it means for something to be made prominent and evident with extra force, whether that thing is to be seen or heard.

“رَأَى أَهْ جَهْرَةً” (*ra ahu jahrah*): to see each other without any curtain or anything in between.

“جَهَرَ الصَّوْتُ” (*jahas saut*): he raised his voice.

“جَهَرَ الْكَلَامَ” (*jaharul kalam*): he said it clearly and openly.

“جَهْرَاءُ الْقَوْمِ” (*jahraul qaum*): the prominent persons of a nation {*T*}.

“جَهَرَ الْقَوْمُ الْقَوْمَ” (*jaharul qaumul qaum*): one tribe attacked another at dawn.

“مُجَابِرَةٌ” (*mujahara*): to try to overwhelm one another {*T*}.

Quran says about Allah that He cannot be seen without a curtain in between (2:55).

Surah Al-Hadeed says that Allah is “هُوَ الظَّاهِرُ” (*az-zahiro*) in 57:3. For its meaning, see headings (Z-He-R) and (B-Te-N).

Surah Al-Anaam uses “جَهَرَ” (*jahr*) as against “سِرٌّ” (*siirr*) in 6:3, and uses it against “كَتَمَ” (*katam*) in 21:110.

Surah Bani Israeel uses it against “خَفَّتْ” (*khaft*).

17:110	Don't shout during your <i>salah</i> , but don't whisper either	وَلَا يَجْهَرُ بِصَلَاتِكَ وَلَا تُخَافِتُ بِهَا
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For *Salah*, see heading (Sd-L-W)

Surah Al-Anaam says:

6:47	If Allah's punishment would strike you suddenly, openly and clearly visible.	إِنْ أَنْتُمْ عَذَابَ اللَّهِ بَعْتُهُ أَوْ جَهْرَةً
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“بَغْتَةً” (*baghtatan*): which has no signs etc. beforehand; therefore “جَهْرَةً” (*jahr*) would mean something whose signs etc. appear beforehand.

Surah Al-Hijrat says:

49:4	don't raise your voice to the Messenger, or do not shout while talking as you are wont to do among yourselves	لَا تَرْفَعُوا أَصْوَاءَكُمْ فَوْقَ صَوْتِ النَّبِيِّ وَلَا تَجْهَرُوا لَهُ بِالْقَوْلِ كَجَهْرِ بَعْضِكُمْ لِبَعْضٍ
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The above translation was the literal meaning of the verse. Figuratively it would mean to not try to give prominence to your opinion over his, accept his decisions with complete acquiescence.

In a Quranic society, the centre's decision is the last word. During his lifetime the Messenger held this position. After him, this position will be transferred to the Caliphs or the center of the Quranic state.

“الْجَهَازُ” (*al-juhaaz*): luggage or load, anything that is needed. {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means anything which can be bought or acquired.

“النَّجْهَيزُ” (*at-tahjeez*): to load the luggage or give it {*T*}.

Surah Yusuf says:

12:59	When they were given their luggage and they got ready for travel.	وَلَمَّا جَهَّزَهُمْ بِجَهَازِهِمْ
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“الْجَهْزَاءُ مِنَ الْأَرْضِ” (*al-jahza'o minal ard*): high land.

“الْجَاهِلُ” (*al-jahl*): to proceed in matters about which one is not familiar.

Raghib says “جَاهِلٌ” (*jahl*) has three meanings

- 1) Human mind to be bereft of knowledge (this is its basic meaning)
- 2) To have the wrong ideas about something
- 3) Not to do something the way it should be done, whether the ideas are wrong or right.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are

- 1) The opposite of knowledge
- 2) Hollowness and discomfort.

“مَجْهَلٌ” (*majhal*): a land without landmarks due to which the right way cannot be seen {T}.

“الْجَاهُولُ” (*al-jahool*) is that simpleton who is easily hoodwinked {M}.

Tajul Uroos says that the word “جَاهِلٌ” (*jaahil*) is used condemnably but sometimes it means to be unaware. In this situation, the word is not used for condemnation.

The Quran says:

2:273	Unaware ones, thinks they are wealthy	يَحْسِبُهُمُ الْجَاهِلُ أَغْنَاءَ
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The word “جَاهِلٌ” (*jahiliyah*) has been used for the Arabic period before Islam.

Quran has used it in 33:33, where it does not mean that they were totally illiterate, but that they were not familiar with the **Deen** (Islam). Here “جَاهِلٌ” (*jahiliyah*) does not mean their illiteracy, but not being familiar with the **Deen** (way of life) that reached them through the Messenger Muhammad. Therefore the traditions and customs of that era include not only the traditions and customs that were prevalent before the advent of Islam, but they also mean the wrong traditions and customs that are spreading due to unfamiliarity with the **Deen** among Muslims.

Besides this, to stick to these traditions even after being aware of Deen, simply because they have been practiced in the past, is “جَاهِلٌ” (*jahiliyah*). It is the religion of stones, not to move from one's old stands. That is why a big rock is called “صَفَاةٌ جَيْهَلٌ” (*safatun jeehal*) {M}. This is the worst form of “جَاهِلٌ” (*jahaalah*) and “جَهْلٌ” (*jahiliyah*) that is why the **Tajul Uroos** calls it “جَهْلٌ مُرَكَّبٌ” (*jahlun murakkab*) or compound “جَاهِلٌ” (*jahiliyah*).

Ahmed Ameen Misri has said that the word “سَلَامٌ” (*salaam*): security which is the opposite of battle or enmity.

Quranic verse is:

25:63	وَعِبَادُ الرَّحْمَنِ الَّذِينَ يَمْشُونَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ هَوْنًا وَإِذَا خَاطَبَهُمُ الْجَاهِلُونَ قَالُوا سَلَامًا
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In the above verse the word “سَلَامٌ” (*salam*) has been used against “جَاهِلِيَّةٌ” (*jahiliyah*). Perhaps this verse will help us find the reason for which the period before the Messenger was termed “جَاهِلِيَّةٌ” (*jahiliyah*) and the period after his coming as **Islam**. This word “جَاهِلِيَّةٌ” (*jahiliyah*) has not been derived from the word “جَاهِلٌ” (*jahl*) which means to be unaware, but it has been derived from the word “جَهْلٌ” (*jahl*) which means foolishness, anger and ego.

Abu Zar Ghaffari is recalled as saying that someone was shamed by naming his mother at which the Messenger said: “إِنَّكَ امْرُؤٌ فِيكَ جَاهِلِيَّةٌ” (*innakam ruwun wafeeka jahiliyah*): you still have the spirit of the “جَاهِلِيَّةٌ” (*jahilia*) period in you.

The Arabs too have a proverb “إِسْتَجْهَلَهُ الشَّيْءُ” (*istajhalahus shaiyi*) which is, that thing made him a stranger to intellect, he has become mad.

A poet has said “دَعَاكَ الْهَوَىٰ وَاسْتَجَبْتَ لَكَ الْمَنَازِلُ” (*da'akal hawa wastajhaltaakal manazil*): love called you and the beloved's talk made you lose your senses.

Umru Bin Kulsoom has said: beware, do not commit any excess on us, or we will commit greater excesses on you:

This shows that the word “جَاهِلِيَّة” (*jahiliyah*) is used for hollowness, leave of senses, bias and false pride etc. which were very important part of the Arab psyche before the advent of Islam. As such that period is called the period of “جَاهِلِيَّة” (*jahiliyah*). As against these are personal satisfactions, the realization of the importance of good deeds, the transitory nature of racial pride, etc. This clarifies as to what Islam is and what “جَاهِلِيَّة” (*jahiliyah*) is.

According to the Quran, it is a crime not to acquire knowledge and to keep following your wrong ways even after acquiring knowledge is a bigger crime.

For more details see headings (*Ain-L-M*) and (*Ain-Q-L*). In surah *Al-Baqrah* this word has appeared with the word “هَزُونٌ” (*hazwun*) in 2:67. Therefore, it means people who don't take life's problems and orders and laws seriously, and take them frivolously.

Jahannum

جَهَنَّمَ

Some think it is Arabic word which means 'deep'.

“رَكِيَّةٌ جَهَنَّمَ” (*rikkaitum jahannam*): a well with a deep bottom. Some others think it is the Arabic form of the Hebrew word *Gahannaam* {T}.

Muheet says that this word is basically from Hebrew and a compound of two words, “جِي” (*ji*) which means a valley and “هَنُوم” (*hanoom*) which was a man's name. The valley of *Hannoom* was a famous valley in the south of Jerusalem in which the god *Molok* was paid tribute by sacrificing (burning) human beings. As such *ji-hanoom* meant a valley where humans were massacred or burnt.

In this context *jahannam* would mean a place for human sacrifice. Allah's law envisages that man's latent capabilities be developed, that humanity be respected and be fruitful. A society in which humanity develops is a heavenly society. Conversely a society in which humanity is slaughtered or burns to ashes is a *jahannami* (hellish) society. There is an Arabic word for it which is “جَهِيمٌ” (*jaheem*), which also means to stop from something. See heading (J-H-M). *Jaheem* is hence the point where development has stopped.

Surah *Bani Israeel* says this about the *Jahannum*:

17:8	<i>jahannam</i> is the stoppage spot (for those who live in disobedience of Allah's Law)	وَجَعَلْنَا جَهَنَّمَ لِلْكَافِرِينَ حَصِيرًا
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Since life progresses continuously (although in various forms) one whose development stops here is not able to reach the next stages. As such he stays in hell or *jahannam* in this world as well as in the Hereafter. What will be the situation in that life, we cannot say anything about today, although we can feel the agony of *jahannam* in this life every day, individually as well as collectively. Collectively, a nation which traverses the wrong path finds its efforts coming to naught instead of being fruitful. This is *jahannam*. The result is ignominy and defeat. Its details will be found at different places in the Quran. In this state the capabilities of the individuals in such a society are burnt to ashes.

One should understand that *jahannam* is formulated by one's own deeds. That is why it has been said:

29:54	surely <i>jahannam</i> is surrounding the deniers from all sides	كَذَلِكَ وَنَزَّلْنَا حُجُوجَهُمْ لِمُحِيطَةٍ بِالْكَافِرِينَ
82:16	it is not hidden from their eyes	وَمَا هُمْ عَنْهَا بِغَائِبِينَ

it is watching them, even as we speak, but they do not feel it. Therefore it is oblivious to them. When their eyes open, it will jump before their eyes and become visible.

79:36	for one who sees, it will be obvious	و تُرِيَّتِ الْجَنَّةُ لِمَن يَرَى
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This is the situation about which it has been said that:

82:15	these people will enter it during the period of the <i>Deen</i>	يَصْلَوْنَهَا يَوْمَ الدِّينِ
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“يَوْمَ الدِّينِ” (*yaumuddeen*) is the period of the results, either in this day or after death.

J-W-B ج و ب

“الْجَوْبُ” (*al-jaub*): to delink, to tear up, to drill a hole. These are the basic meanings of this root.

The Quran says:

89:8	and <i>Samood</i> who used to carve the mountains (and made them their homes)	وَتُؤَدُّ الَّذِينَ حَابُّوا الصَّخْرَ بِالْوَادِ
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“الْجَوْبَةُ” (*al-jaubah*): a ditch in which rainwater accumulates behind the house {T}.

“الْجَوْبُ” (*al-jaub*) also means a shield {T}.

“أَجَابُ” (*ajaab*), “يُجِيبُ” (*yujib*), “إِجَابَةً” (*ajaba*), “إِجَابَةٌ” (*ijabah*), they all mean ‘to reply’ because one answers the questioner and the answer leaves his mouth and travels to the questioner’s ears, and thus cuts or shortens the distance.

A question is of two types. One is inquiring about something and secondly to ask for help or assistance. As such, replies are also of two kinds, and to satisfy and help both would constitute the answer. That is, to answer somebody’s question or to fulfil someone’s demand.

The question also cuts the distance but this word has become special for an answer {R}. This has led to “مُجِيبٌ” (*mujeeb*), one who answers.

The Quran says:

11:61	Verily my Sustainer is near and He answers as well.	إِنَّ رَبِّي قَرِيبٌ مُّجِيبٌ
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Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:186	I answer any caller when he calls out to me	أُجِيبُ دَعْوَةَ الدَّاعِ إِذَا دَعَانِ
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For prayer and God’s answer to it, see heading (*D-Ain-W*). Here let it suffice to say that prayer means to observe the laws of Allah and by Allah’s answering to it means the outcome of an action.

Surah *Al-Momin* says:

40:60	your developer (one who sustains your growth) says call me and I will answer you	وَقَالَ رَبُّكُمْ ادْعُونِي أَسْتَجِبْ لَكُمْ
40:60	those people who are rebellious and do not obey me will be badly humiliated and enter Jahannam	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَسْتَكْبِرُونَ عَنْ عِبَادَتِي سَيَدْخُلُونَ جَهَنَّمَ دَاخِرِينَ

This whole verse makes it evident that prayer in reality is the opposite of “يُرُونَ عَنْ عِبَادَتِي” (*yastakberoona un ibadati*). As such, prayer means God’s dominance.

That is why it is said a little earlier:

40:50	Those who refuse observance of Allah's laws, never have their prayers bring any results.	وَمَا دُعَاءُ الْكَافِرِينَ إِلَّا فِي ضَلَالٍ
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This is why when it is said in surah *Al-Baqrah*:

2:186	I answer every caller's call	أَجِبْ دَعْوَةَ الدَّاعِ إِذَا دَعَانِ
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Along with it is also said:

2:186	As such they should have faith in My laws and obey me (If they do this, I will certainly make their efforts bear fruit)	فَلْيَسْتَجِيبُوا لِلَّهِ وَلِلْيَوْمِئَاتِ
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This is the real meaning of prayer and the acceptance of prayer, which is, if you fulfill whatever is Allah's requirement are, then He will fulfill your demands. This is Allah's law. He does not let anyone's efforts in obeying Him go waste.

11:115	and be steadfast: verily Allah does not let the <i>mohsineen</i> 's efforts go waste: and nothing can be acquired without effort	وَصَبِرْ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُضِيعُ أَجْرَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ
53:39	Man can get nothing but for which he has tried	وَأَنْ لَّيْسَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ إِلَّا مَا سَعَى

Questioning is of two kinds, one is to ask about something and the other to ask for some help. As such, replies too will be of two kinds, and the words used for them are to answer someone's query or to fulfill someone's demand.

J-W-D

ج و د

“الْجَيِّدُ” (*al-jayyid*): a good thing.

“جَوْدَةٌ” (*jaudah*): to be a good thing.

“أَجَادَهُ” (*ajadah*): made it good.

“الْجَوَادُ” (*al-jawad*): philanthropist.

“الْجَوْدِيُّ” (*al-joodi*): is the name of the mount on which *Nooh's* boat came to a stop (11:44).

“جَوَادٌ” (*jawwad*): horse of a good breed which runs fast and uses all his energy in running {R}. Plural is

“جِيَادٌ” (*jee'aad*).

It is said that it is situated in the mountain range which divides *Armenia* and *Mesopotamia*.

Surah *Saad* says:

38:31	thorough bred speedy stallions	الصُّفُنُ الثَّيَالُ
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J-W-R

ج و ر

“الْجَوْرُ” (*al-jaur*): to leave the middle path and move to one side. This made it mean injustice and oppression.

“جَارٌ” (*jaar*): to leave the path of justice {T}.

The Quran has used “جَائِرٌ” (*jayir*) against “قَصْدُ السَّبِيلِ” (*qasdu sabeel*) in 16:9. “قَصْدُ السَّبِيلِ” (*qasdu sabeel*) is the middle way and “جَائِرٌ” (*jayir*) is a lopsided path.

“الْجَارُ” (*al-jaar*): neighbour, the person whom you have sheltered against someone's oppression. It is also used to mean companion, and helper {T}.

The Quran has stated “الْجَارِ ذِي الْقُرْبَىٰ” (*al-jaari zil qurba*) and “الْجَارِ الْجُنُبِ” (*al-jaaril junub*) in 4:36. For details see heading (J-N-B).

The Quran says:

33:60	they will not be able to live like your neighbours in this city.	لَا يُجَاوِزُونَكَ فِيهَا
8:48	I am your sheltered, or supporter or helper:	إِنِّي جَارٌ لَّكُمْ
13:4	adjacent plots of land	قِطْعَ مَتَجَرَّاتٍ

“أَجَارَهُ” (*ajarah*): shelter him, provided him with shelter, took him in his protection (72:22).

“اسْتَجَارَ” (*istajjar*): to ask for shelter.

J-W-Z

ج و ز

“جَاوَزَ الْمَوْضِعَ” (*jaazul mauzeh*): he went past that place, left it behind. If it is a river, it would mean to have crossed the river.

“جَاوَزَ” (*jawaz*): to go beyond some place or spot {T} (2:249, 18:62).

The real meaning of this root is to delink, cut off {M}.

“تَجَوَّزَ عَنْ ذَنْبِهِ” (*tajjawwaza un zambhia*): overlooked his error.

46:16	We overlook their mistakes	وَنَتَجَاوَزُ عَنْ سَيِّئَاتِهِمْ
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Ibn Faris says the basic meaning is to cut off something or the middle of something.

“جَوَزَ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ” (*jauzu kulla shaiyun*): the middle or center of everything.

“الْجَائِزُ” (*al-jayizo*): something which passes through the middle of something.

“الْجَائِزُ” (*al-jayizo*): one who passes through the right way {M}.

“الْمَجَازُ” (*almajaz*): road which is cut from one end to another or the road which is heavily traversed {T}.

“الْجَائِزَةُ” (*al-jayizah*): gift, reward, the goods given to a traveller for a day and night. It is possible that this led to its meaning a gift or reward.

J-W-S

ج و س

“الْجَوْسُ” (*al-jaus*): to search for something to the utmost, to roam around {T, R}.

“الْأَجْتِيَّاسُ” (*al-ajtiyas*): to roam at night {T}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to penetrate something.

The Quran says:

17:5	they penetrated your cities and searched everywhere for you (and in this way murdered or arrested you after seeking out each one)	فَجَاسُوا خِلَالَ الدِّيَارِ
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Muheet has included the meanings of moving hither and thither to attack or loot.

“الْجُوعُ” (*al-jooh*): hunger:
 “جَاعَ” (*ja’a*), “يَجُوعُ” (*yajooh*), “جَوْعاً” (*joo’a*): to be hungry.
 “عَامٌ مَجَاعَةٌ” (*aamu maja’ati*): year of hunger, drought.

The Quran has used it for hunger in 2:155 and one specialty of the *jannat* has been mentioned that there will never be hunger (shortage of sustenance). It also means to hide life’s accoutrements or to misuse the results:

20:118	you will never remain hungry there	إِنَّ لَكَ الْآخِرَةَ فِيهَا
16:112	the punishment of hunger and fear	لِبَاسُ الْجَنَّةِ وَالْخَوْفِ

For any nation, the shortage of sustenance or is a sort of punishment, or restriction, while its abundance is a particularity of a heavenly society. Nobody can go hungry in a society that follows the Quran. This by no count means that in a society, if no man goes hungry the society will be called a heavenly society.

God's order has many particularities and unless the society meets them all, it cannot be called a *jannati* society, but a society in which people go hungry and cannot feed their children, is by no means a *jannati* society nor is its order Allah's system. It is possible that for some time there is a shortage of food (during wars etc.), but as a permanent value, hunger is God's punishment, and a nation which does not want to get rid of such a system, wants to remain in hell forever.

“الْجَوْفُ” (*al-jauf*): vast low land, stomach, or the insides of something.
 “جَوْفُ الْبَيْتِ” (*jaufal bait*): the inside of the house.

Ibn Faris says that it basically means the inside of something.

“جَافَهُ” (*jafah*), “يَجُوفُهُ” (*yajoofah*), “جَوْفًا” (*jaufa*): he deepened it.
 “جَوْفٌ” (*jawwaf*): something with depth, as against “مُحَدَّبٌ” (*muhaddaf*) which means a man who has no heart (coward), a man with a hollow chest {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

33:4	Allah has not created two hearts in anyone’s chest.	مَا جَعَلَ اللَّهُ لِرَجُلٍ مِنْ قَلْبَيْنِ فِي جَوْفِهِ
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Here “جَوْفٌ” (*jauf*): chest.

“الْجَوُّ” (*al-ajju*): the atmosphere, the space between the earth and the outer space {*T, M, R*}.

Quran uses it to refer to the celestial atmosphere:

16:79	the birds have conquered (mastered) the atmosphere:	مُسَخَّرَاتٍ فِي حَوِّ السَّمَاءِ
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However, “الْجَوُّ” (*al-ajju*) also means the inside of a house {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it means a thing which is encompassing another or surrounding another. The outer atmosphere is called “الْجَوُّ” (*al-ajju*) because it seems to be surrounding the earth.

“جَاءَ” (*ja'a*), “يَجِي” (*yajyi*): to come.

“أَنَا أَجَأْتُهُ وَجَعْتُ بِهِ” (*aja'to hu wa jey'to behi*): I brought him {T}.

Raghib says while differentiating between “إِنِّيَانٌ” (*ityaan*) and “الْمَجِيءُ” (*majee*) that “إِنِّيَانٌ” (*ityaan*) means to intend to do something (whether or not it can be performed) but “الْمَجِيءُ” (*aljiyo*) will be said when some work has been completed.

It also means to bring and to commit or do. People said to **Maryam**:

19:27	you have done a strange thing (you have committed a strange act)	لَقَدْ جَاءَتْ شَيْئاً فَرِيئاً
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Similarly in surah **Al-Kahaf** it is said in the tale about **Moosa** and the old man:

18:71	You have committed a dangerous act.	لَقَدْ جَعَلْتَ شَيْئاً إِمْرًا
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Surah **Maryam** says:

19:23	the labor pains brought her near the date palm	فَأَجَاءَهَا الْمَخَاضُ إِلَى جُذْعِ النَّخْلَةِ
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This signifies a sort of compulsion.

“جَيْبُ الْقَمِيصِ” (*jaibul qamees*): the neck of a loose shirt.

“الْجَيْبُ” (*al-jaib*) is also used for the chest on which the front of the shirt rests, and it also means the heart.

“هُوَ نَاصِحٌ الْجَيْبِ” (*hauna sehool jaib*): he is a clear hearted or clean chested person, meaning that he is sincere {T}.

Surah **An-Noor** tells women:

23:36	they should put their long narrow cloth on their chests.	وَلْيَضْرِبْنَ خُمُرَهُنَّ عَلَى جُيُوبِهِنَّ
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In the tale about **Moosa**, it is said:

27:12	enter your hand in your shirt	وَأَدْخِلْ يَدَكَ فِي جَيْبِكَ
28: 32	put your hand in your shirt	أَسْلُكْ يَدَكَ فِي جَيْبِكَ

For the meanings of these above verses, see heading (Y-D-Y) and (B-Y-Zd).

“جِيدٌ” (*jeed*): the neck, the front part of the neck, or the part of the neck where necklaces hang.

According to a saying “جِيدٌ” (*jeed*) is said when in praise, and when in condemnation, “عُنُقٌ” (*oonuq*) is used.

About **Abu Lahab's** wife, the Quran says:

111:5	her neck has a rope made out of date palm leaves	فِي جِيدٍ هَاجِلٍ مِّنْ مَّسَدٍ
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That is, the neck (or person) which was so respected and exalted is being humiliated in this manner. Her pride is being trampled into dust.

LUGHAT-UL-QURAN

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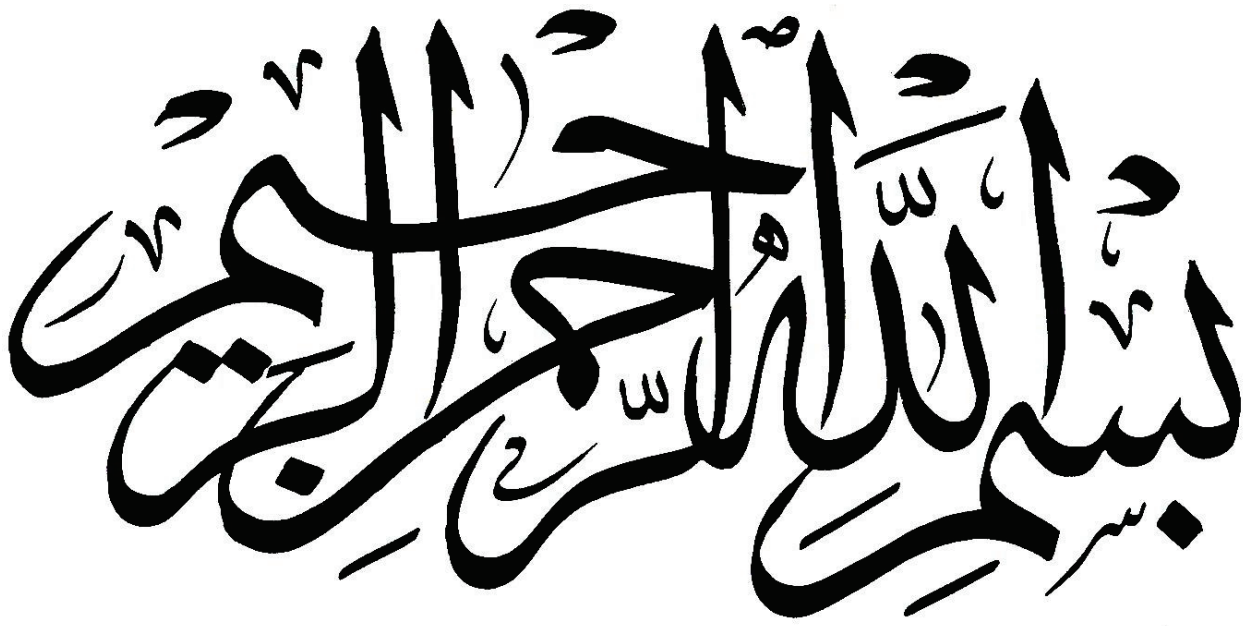
VOLUME II

Ebook edition

Originally compiled in Urdu by
Allama Ghulam Ahmad Parwez

Edited/Translated by:
Sheraz Akhtar - Quranic Education Society Norway

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Translator and editor: Sheraz Akhtar

Published by: Quranic Education Society, Oslo - Norway

In association with Tolu-e-Islam Trust, Lahore - Pakistan

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Z-R-Ain	269	ز ر ع	S-D-D	317	س د د	S-M-W	354	س م و
Z-R-Q	271	ز ر ق	S-D-R	317	س د ر	S-N-B-L	355	س ن ب ل
Z-R-Y	271	ز ر ی	S-D-S	318	س د س	S-N-D	356	س ن د
Z-Ain-M	271	ز ع م	S-D-Y	319	س د ی	S-N-D-S	356	س ن د س
Z-F-R	272	ز ف ر	S-R-B	319	س ر ب	S-N-M	356	س ن م
Z-F-F	272	ز ف ف	S-R-B-L	320	س ر ب ل	S-N-N	357	س ن ن
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Z-L-Q	278	ز ل ق	S-R-R	323	س ر ر	S-He-L	360	ش ه ل
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Z-L-M	279	ز ل م	S-R-F	324	س ر ف	S-He-W	361	س ه و
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Z-M-L	280	ز م ل	S-R-M-D	325	س ر م د	Suw'a	362	س و ا ع
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Z-W-D	287	ز و د	S-F-H	331	س ف ح	S-W-M	369	س و م
Z-W-R	287	ز و ر	S-F-R	332	س ف ر	S-W-Y	370	س و ی
Z-W-L	288	ز و ل	S-F-Ain	333	س ف ع	S-Y-B	371	س ی ب
Z-Y-T	288	ز ی ت	S-F-K	333	س ف ک	S-Y-H	372	س ی ح
Z-Y-D	289	ز ی د	S-F-L	333	س ف ل	S-Y-R	372	س ی ر
Z-Y-Gh	289	ز ی غ	S-F-N	335	س ف ن	S-Y-L	373	س ی ل
Z-Y-L	290	ز ی ل	S-F-H	335	س ف ه	Seen	373	سین
Z-Y-N	290	ز ی ن	S-Q-R	336	س ق ر	Sh-A-M	374	ش ا م
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S-A-L	293	س ا ل	S-Q-F	336	س ق ف	Sh-B-H	375	ش ب ه
S-A-M	294	س ا م	S-Q-M	337	س ق م	Sh-T-T	375	ش ت ت
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S-B-B	295	س ب ب	S-K-B	339	س ک ب	Sh-J-R	376	ش ج ر
S-B-T	295	س ب ت	S-K-T	339	س ک ت	Sh-H-H	377	ش ح ح
S-B-H	296	س ب ح	S-K-R	339	س ک ر	Sh-H-M	377	ش ح م
S-B-Te	298	س ب ط	S-K-N	340	س ک ن	Sh-Kh-Sd	378	ش خ ص
S-B-Ain	298	س ب ع	S-L-B	342	س ل ب	Sh-H-N	378	ش ح ن
S-B-Gh	299	س ب غ	S-L-H	343	س ل ح	Sh-D-D	378	ش د د
S-B-Q	301	س ب ق	S-L-Kh	343	س ل خ	Sh-R-B	379	ش ر ب
S-B-L	302	س ب ل	S-L-S-L	343	س ل س ل	Sh-R-H	379	ش ر ح
S-T-T	304	س ت ت	S-L-Te	344	س ل ط	Sh-R-D	380	ش ر د
S-T-R	304	س ت ر	S-L-F	345	س ل ف	Sh-R-Dh-M	380	ش ر ذ م
S-J-D	305	س ج د	S-L-Q	345	س ل ق	Sh-R-R	380	ش ر ر
S-J-R	309	س ج ر	S-L-K	346	س ل ک	Sh-R-Te	382	ش ر ط
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S-J-N	310	س ج ن	S-L-M	347	س ل م	Sh-R-Q	384	ش ر ق
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S-H-B	312	س ح ب	Suleman	350	سلیمان	Sh-R-Y	386	ش ر ی
S-H-Te	312	س ح ت	S-M-D	350	س م د	Sh-Te-A	387	ش ط ا
S-H-R	313	س ح ر	S-M-R	351	س م ر	Sh-Te-R	387	ش ط ر
S-H-Q	314	س ح ق	S-M-Ain	351	س م ع	Sh-Te-Te	387	ش ط ط

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Sh-Q-W(Y)	ش ق و(ی).....399
Sh-K-R	ش ک ر.....400
Sh-K-S	ش ک س.....402
Sh-K-K	ش ک ک.....402
Sh-K-L	ش ک ل.....403
Sh-K-W(Y)	ش ک و(ی).....404
Sh-M-T	ش م ت.....404
Sh-M-Kh	ش م خ.....404
Sh-M-Z	ش م ز.....405
Sh-M-S	ش م س.....405
Sh-M-L	ش م ل.....406
Sh-N-A	ش ن أ.....406
Sh-He-B	ش ه ب.....407
Sh-He-D	ش ه د.....407
Sh-He-R	ش ه ر.....408
Sh-He-Q	ش ه ق.....409
Sh-He-W	ش ه و.....409
Sh-W-B	ش و ب.....410
Sh-W-R	ش و ر.....410
Sh-W-Ze	ش و ط.....411
Sh-W-K	ش و ک.....411
Sh-W-Y	ش و ی.....411
Sh-Y-A	ش ی أ.....412
Sh-Y-B	ش ی ب.....415
Sh-Y-Kh	ش ی خ.....415
Sh-Y-D	ش ی د.....416
Sh-Y-Ain	ش ی ع.....416

”الْحَاشِيَّةُ“ (*al-hashiyaa*): edge/border (of cloth etc.)

”حَشَوَةُ النَّاسِ“ (*hashwatun naas*): lowly people (i.e. those who are kept on the periphery). From this it came to mean distance.

”حَاشَ لِلَّهِ“ (*hasha lillah*): Allah is very far from him, or I seek Allah’s protection.

”الْحَاشِيَّةُ“ (*al-hashiyaa*) also mean people who live under someone’s protection {T}.

The Quran says:

12:31	they said Allah is without any blemish or fault (he is flawless)	وَقُلْنَ حَاشَ لِلَّهِ
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This is used for exemption, i.e. to be exempt of any fault or blemish {R}.

Muheet says ”الْحُبُّ“ (*al-hoob*) or ”الْمَحَبَّةُ“ (*al-muhabbah*) has five meanings:

- 1) Whiteness and cleanliness. Hence, ”حَبُّ الْأَسْنَانِ“ (*hababul asnaan*) means “the sparkle of teeth”.
- 2) To rise or to be high, to appear ”حَبَابُ الْمَائِنِ“ (*hubaabul ma’a*) has come from it and it means a water bubble.
- 3) For something to be stable in its place. Hence, ”حَبَّ الْبَيْعُرِ وَ أَحَبَّ“ (*habbal bayeero wa ahab*) means “the camel sat down so adamantly that it did not get up after that”.
- 4) For something to be pure or its real element, like ”حَبَّةُ الْقَلْبِ“ (*habbatul qalb*): pureness of heart.
- 5) To protect someone, to hold.

This is why ”حُبُّ الْمَاءِ“ (*hubbul ma’a*) is a canter or skin tank in which water can be preserved.

”حَبُّ الرَّجُلِ“ (*habbur rajul*) means the man stopped.

”أَحَبَّ الزَّرْعُ“ (*ahabbaz zara*), the fields were sowed, that is, the results of their development began to appear {M}.

Raghib says ”الْمَحَبَّةُ“ (*al-muhabbah*) means to want something which is found to be good and beneficial. This has three aspects.

- One is for pleasure like a man loves a woman.
- Second is to like or want material things which are beneficial in some way.
- Third is to love figurative matters as scholars like each other because of the knowledge they have.

Sometimes love is also said to mean intent, but love has more of force and strength than intent {R}.

”إِسْتَحَبَّ“ (*istahabba*): liked him/her,

”إِسْتَحَبَّ عَلَيْهِ“ (*istahabba alaih*): preferred him over another. (12:107)

Ibn Faris says ”الْحُبُّ“ (*al-hoob*) and ”الْمَحَبَّةُ“ (*al-muhabba*) mean to think someone is essential. The basic meanings of this root are essentiality and stability. That is to think that something is essential and to stay with it with steadfastness.

The Quran has used the word ”حُبُّ“ (*hoob*) as against ”كُرْهُ“ (*kurhun*). Here it means liking, as in 49:7 or 2:216. These meanings need no explanation, but where ever love for Allah is mentioned, it needs to be clarified.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:165	and there are people who consider other forces to be Allah’s contemporaries and love those forces as they love Allah although those who have <i>Imaan</i> (those who trust), love Allah in much greater degree:	وَمِنَ النَّاسِ مَن يَتَّخِذُ مِن دُونِ اللَّهِ أَندَادًا يُحِبُّوهُمْ كَحُبِّ اللَّهِ وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَشَدُّ حُبًّا لِلَّهِ
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This is the general translation of this verse.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:30 3:31	Tell them if you love Allah then follow me; Allah will love you too, and pardon your sins: and Allah is most merciful and protector. Tell them to obey God and his messengers, but if they turn away from this, then (be warned) that Allah does not like the deniers.	قُلْ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ فَاتَّبِعُوا نَبِيَّ يُحِبُّكُمُ اللَّهُ وَيَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ ذُنُوبَكُمْ وَ اللَّهُ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ قُلْ أَطِيعُوا اللَّهَ وَالرَّسُولَ فَإِنْ تَوَلَّوْا فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ الْكَافِرِينَ
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This is the traditional translation.

These verses are quoted as proof for the love for and by Allah's and the edifice of *tasawwuf* (Mysticism/Sufism) is built upon it. This love is so great that its height is deemed to merge with His personae. This whole concept is born due to taking love to mean as we human beings take it to mean.

A relationship of this kind with God is not Quranic. As far as God's personae are concerned, it is beyond our comprehension, and Therefore, there is no question of love as one would love a beloved (even if it's one's child). To love an unseen body in this manner is psychologically impossible. This was the difficulty which compelled Man to believe in God's incarnation in human form or to make statues of Him. Everything will be clear if we recall the meanings of love given in the beginning.

“حُبُّ” (*hoob*) means “to be steadfast”. Therefore, loving Allah would mean to be stable and unwavering about Allah's orders and to follow them steadfastly, to be resolute about them and not waver over them. The verses above are testifying to these meaning.

See verse 2:165 of surah *Baqrah* which says “those who consider others to be powerful, and follow their laws and decisions as well”. Therefore, here love of Allah means following His laws.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran*'s verse 3:30:31 explains this: here “إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ” (*inn kuntum tuhibboonillaha*) has been expostulated by “أَطِيعُوا اللَّهَ” (*atiullah*) which is to obey Allah.

As against it “تَوَلَّوْا” (*tuwallau*) has been used. This word further clarifies the meaning. As such, in these verses love of Allah means following His orders, which come under a centralized system, which is formed for establishing His laws.

Surah *Al-Maidah*'s verse 5:54-55 supports this. In these verses, it has been said to the believers that if anyone among them turns his back from this way of life, then he should well understand that Allah's way of life is not dependent upon him. He must not think that if he leaves this way of life, then there will be nobody to take care of it.

Allah will replace them with people who are “يُحِبُّهُمْ” (*yuhibbohum*) and “يُحِبُّونَهُ” (*yuhibbunahu*), i.e. those who love Allah. Allah will also love them. This means that they will be very soft with their own and liable to dominate others. They will struggle continuously and will not be deterred by any detractor or condemner.

The next verse says:

5:55	Allah, the messenger and the believers are your friends	إِنَّمَا وَلِيُّكُمُ اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا
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This makes it clear that by “love” here means to be close to someone, as a friend. Ahead the *Mominen* are told not to befriend the deniers in 5:57. This too makes it clear of what ‘to love Allah’ means, which is to follow His laws. Now as far as Allah loving Man is concerned, one needs to recall the other meaning of the word i.e. to protect, to hold, to elicit strong capabilities, or acts to produce results. Thus, Allah's love would mean the appearance of all those results that are inevitable to obeying His laws. This is the true meaning of Man loving Allah and vice versa. This is also the meaning of being Allah's *wali* (friend) or Allah being Man's *wali*. See heading (*W-L-Y*).

“حَبُّ” (*hub*) also means grain, cereal and crop, as used in 55:12
 “حَبَّةٌ” (*habba*): singular of grain as used in 2:261.

- “الْحَبِيرُ” (*al-hibr*) means ink.
 “الْمَحْبَرَةُ” (*al-mihbarah*) means inkpot.
 “الْحَبِيرِيُّ” (*al-hibri*) means one who sells ink.
 “الْحَبِيرُ” (*al-hibr*) is the knowledge of authors, especially a Jewish scholar {*T*}.
 “حَبَارٌ” (*ahbaar*) is the plural form as used in 5:44.
 “الْحَبِيرُ” (*al-hibr*) means beauty and its glow.
 “الْحَبْرُ” (*al-habr*) means pleasure, bliss, and happiness.
 “حَبْرَةٌ” (*habrah*) is complete bliss and comfort, abundance of luxury.
 “الْحَبْرَةُ” (*al-habra*) means music in heaven or *jannat*, good song.

The Quran says:

30:15	So they shall be delighted in the gardens	فَهُمْ فِي رَوْضَةٍ يُحْبَرُونَ
43:70	Enter the jannah delightfully, you and your spouses	أَدْخُلُوا الْجَنَّةَ أَنْتُمْ وَزَوَاجُكُمْ يُحْبَرُونَ

Zajaj says the dictionary says that “الْحَبْرَةُ” (*al-habra*) means a good song {*T*}. Actually it encompasses all the aspects of happiness and pleasure, whether they are with the blissfulness of sight or sound, masterpieces of art or music.

Ibn Faris says it means such signs which highlight the beauty of a thing.

- “حَبَّرَ الْخَطَّ وَالشَّعْرَ” (*habbaral khatta wash-sheyr*): he polished the letter and the verse, and made it beautiful.
 “تَحَبَّرَ الرَّجُلُ” (*tahabbarar rajul*): the man became handsome and beautified {*M*}.
 “تَوْبُ حَبِيرٍ” (*taubun habeer*): good, new cloth.
 “الْيَحْبُورُ” (*al-yahboor*): a man with a delicate body {*T*}.

Raghib says that “الْحَبِيرُ” (*al-hibr*) means a very good and beautiful sign.

“الْحَبِيرُ” (*al-habao*) means a scholar, because his knowledge has an effect on people and his better signs and steps are followed.

The Quran enunciates the appreciation of every beautiful thing in the universe and stresses enjoying it (its beauty), with the condition that Man stays within the limits set by God and does not transgress.

A heavenly society is the one in which art and music are cause for delight in their respective places, and since all the time Allah's limits are kept in view, they are not the cause of ill effects.

The Quran has mentioned every aspect of beauty and adornment in the context of heavenly life, but life turns heavenly only when Allah's laws are implemented and followed.

- “الْحَبْسُ” (*al-habs*): to stop, to imprison.
 “إِحْتَبَسَهُ” (*ihtabasahu*): stopped him.
 “فَأَحْتَبَسَ” (*fa ahtabus*): Thus, he stopped.
 “الْمَحْبُوسُ” (*al-mahbus*): the eating pot of animals {*T*}. It also means a ring which is put on the fingers {*M*}.
 “حَبَسَهُ عَنْهُ” (*habasahu unhu*): to stop someone from (doing) something.
 “حَبَسَهُ عَلَيْهِ” (*habasahu alaihi*) means to devote {*M*}.

The Quran says:

5:106	(you should) stop those two witnesses	تَحْبِسُوهُمَا
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“الْحَبَطُ” (*al-habat*): the scar that remains even after the wound has healed.

“الْحَبَاةُ” (*al-habaat*): an animal disease in which the stomach swells and the animal dies

Zamkhashri and Ibnul Atheer say that “حَبَطَتِ الدَّابَّةُ حَبَطًا” (habetatin da’abbatin habata) means an animal overeating upon reaching a very good grazing land but not being able to digest the food it has eaten. Hence, this makes its stomach swell and it dies {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to be proven false; pain and sorrow.

Quran has used the terms “حَبَطَ أَعْمَالُ” (*habatey aamaal*) (the futility of actions) rather being meaningful, as in 2:217.

If whatever an animal eats gets well digested, it becomes a part of the body and adds to the animal’s health due to which it becomes strong and plump. But if its fodder is not digested, then its stomach swells, and it seems like the animal is fattening. But in fact it is a sign that the animal will die. Similarly human beings do a lot of things which appear very good to him, and he expects very good results from those acts, but they are actually the cause of his annihilation.

The Quran calls this “حَبَطَ أَعْمَالُ” (*habtey aamaal*) that is, not getting the good results that one expected those acts to produce. The fact is that only such acts can produce good results as which are committed under the right system of Allah’s orders. If this is not so, then all Man’s efforts go waste, and the result is nothing but destruction.

2:217	whose efforts go waste in this world and also in the Hereafter:	أُولَئِكَ حَبَطَتْ أَعْمَالُهُمْ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ
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Their efforts only leave traces, there are no results, Thus, good deeds are not those which we think are so, but the criterion for good and bad deeds is the Book of Allah. The deeds which according to Him are not good can never produce good results no matter how good they may appear to us. No matter how good our intentions are, in the universal balance, decisions are not made according to our likes or dislikes, but according to the unchanging values of Allah. That is why the Quran has not only pontificated the good deeds but also mentioned what results they will produce, so that we can judge whether we are traversing the right path or not. If our deeds are not producing the results mentioned by the Quran, then we must understand that our deeds are not according to the Quran. If we do not keep taking stock and continue in our self-deception, then all our deeds will go waste.

18:105	Thus, their deeds did not produce any result; and on the day of the judgment, we will not even ready the scales (to weigh their deeds)	فَحَبَطَتْ أَعْمَالُهُمْ فَلَا تُقِيمُ لَهُمْ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ وَزْنًا
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We must ponder over many of our deeds that are going to waste, and we never stop to think why this is happening, although Allah’s Book (the ever true criterion of deeds) is with us.

As mentioned earlier, **Ibn Faris** has said the basic meanings of the root are not only to go to waste, but also pain and sorrow.

That means that the deeds will not only go waste, but also be cause for pain and sorrow. That is, deeds which were supposed to produce good results have been so wasted.

“الْحَبَكُ” (*al-habak*): to secure tightly.
 “الْحَبَكَةُ” (*al-habakah*): the place where a belt is tied, i.e. the waist.
 “تَحَبَّكَ تَحَبُّكَ” (*tahabbaka tahheboka*): tied the *azaar* (belt) on his waist
 “الْحُبْكُ” (*al-hubkah*): a rope which is tied to the waist.
 “الْحَبُوكُ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ” (*al-hoboka minas sama-ee*): the path of the stars (orbits).
 “حُبُوكُ الرَّمْلِ” (*hobokar raml*): waves of sand.

Fara'a says “حَبَكُ” (*hubk*) means for something to twist and bend or break. As such, “الْحَبُوكُ مِنَ الشَّعْرِ” (*al-hobok mina-sha'ar*) also means curly hair which grow twisted with split ends.
 “الْحَبْكُ” (*al-habka*) means to cut and cutting of the neck {*T, R, M*}.

The Quran says:

51:7	the sky with pathways (or orbits):	وَالسَّمَاءِ ذَاتِ الْحُبُوكِ
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And if it is taken to mean strength, then the verse would mean such high atmosphere where each body moves in its orbit and doesn't move away from its orbit. As such “الْحَبَاكُ” (*al-hibaak*) is that bunch of wooden pieces which are bound tightly together so none of the pieces moves from its place {*T*}, and if it is taken to mean break, then it would mean the atmosphere with celestial bodies in which they are orbiting after originally breaking away from their source (meteors).

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings include something's continuity, longevity and strength. Thus, verse 51:7 would mean such height (atmosphere) which has long or big orbits for the celestial bodies.

“الْحَبْلُ” (*al-habl*): something to tie with, a rope. The plural is “حَبَالٌ” (*hibaal*).
 “حَبَلَهُ” (*hablah*): tied him with a rope {*T*}.

Surah *Taha* says “حَبَالُهُمْ” (*hibalohum*) in 20:66, which means ropes.
 “الْحَبْلُ” (*al-habl*) also means pact, responsibility, and security.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:102	all of you, hold on to the rope of Allah (be linked to Him)	وَأَعْتَصِمُوا بِحَبْلِ اللَّهِ جَمِيعًا
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Here *Taj-ul-Uroos* says that “حَبْلٌ” (*habal*) means ‘pact’.
 The author of *Kitabil Ashqaq* also supports this meaning.
Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is the longevity of anything.
Raghib says anything through which one reaches another thing is “حَبْلٌ” (*habal*). Thus, “حَبْلُ اللَّهِ” (*hablullah*) means the thing which takes you to Allah i.e. the Noble Quran.
Abu Ubaid says “أَلَا عَتَصَامُ بِحَبْلِ اللَّهِ” (*al-etesaamiu bihablil lah*) means following the Quran.
Ibn Masood has also taken “حَبْلُ اللَّهِ” (*hablullah*) to mean the Quran.
Ibn Arfah says that at one place in the Quran it says:

3:111	Allah's responsibility or the responsibility given by the people.	إِلَّا يَحْبِلُ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَحَبْلٌ مِنَ النَّاسِ
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As such in 3:102 “حَبْلُ اللَّهِ” (*hablillah*) means responsibility towards Allah {*T*}.

But whatever we take the word to mean, rope or the means, responsibility or pact. It is all the same, our relationship or link is through the Quran. This is the rope that has come to us from Him and which binds us together. The next part of the verse says “وَلَا تَفَرَّقُوا” (*wala tafarraqu*) (i.e. do not be dissected), and beyond that the *momineen* have been told to stay as one group or party. See 3:103 and 3:109.

Thus, “حَبْلُ اللَّهِ” (*habalillah*) means the collective system which is based on the Quran and whose purpose is unity of the nation and following of Allah’s laws.

The Quran says about Allah:

50:16	We are closer to Man than his <i>hablul vareed</i> .	وَنَحْنُ أَقْرَبُ إِلَيْهِ مِنْ حَبْلِ الْوَرِيدِ
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Fara’a says that “حَبْلٌ” (*hablil*) and “الْوَرِيدُ” (*al-vareed*) has the same meaning and that is of lifeline {T}.

This nearness of God to Man has been explained in the first part of the verse by saying:

50:16	We are even familiar with his breath	وَنَعْلَمُ مَا تُوسُوسُ بِهِ نَفْسُهُ
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The reference is the knowledge of Allah who is All Knowing and on which the wheel of nature depends, and no human deed, not even a passing thought, is outside His Knowledge.

50:17	There is a guard (watchman) on every human deed.	مَا يَلْفُظُ مِنْ قَوْلٍ إِلَّا لَدَيْهِ رَقِيبٌ عَتِيدٌ
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This is how god is closer than one’s lifeline.

H-T-M ح ت م

“حَتَمَهُ وَحَتَمَ بِكَذَا” (*hatamahu way hatama bekaza*), “يَحْتِمُ” (*behtim*), “حَتْمًا” (*hatman*): he decided about something
 “حَتَمَ عَلَيْهِ الْأَمْرَ” (*hatama alaihil amr*): something was made compulsory for him
 “الْحَاتِمُ” (*al-haatim*): one who decides, one who makes a decision to be compulsory on someone {T, M}

The Quran says:

19:71	This has been decided by your Sustainer.	كَانَ عَلَى رَبِّكَ حَتْمًا مَقْضِيًّا
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Ibn Faris says that this word has no root but a mutation where (*ta*) has been changed out by (*kaaf*). He claims that “حَتَمَ” (*hatam*) in fact was “حَكَمَ” (*hakam*) which means to decide.

Hatta حَتَّى

“حَتَّى” (*hatta*) is used in the following meanings:

30:91	they said we will continue doing this, <i>until</i> <i>Moosa</i> doesn’t return to us	قَالُوا لَنْ نَبْرَحَ عَلَيْهِ عَاكِفِينَ حَتَّى يَرْجِعَ إِلَيْنَا مُوسَى
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Sometimes it means ‘so that’, as some say it means in this verse

2:217	And these people will continue fighting you <i>so that</i> if they may, they will force you to revert from your way of life	وَلَا يَزَالُونَ يُقَاتِلُونَكُمْ حَتَّى يَرُدُّوكُمْ عَنْ دِينِكُمْ إِنِ اسْتَطَاعُوا
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This means that their purpose is of fighting you....

Sometimes it also means the same as “إِلَّا” (*illa*) which means “rather”, as quoted by both *Taj-ul-Uroos* and *Muheet* with reference to *Ibn Maalik* in the verse that means:

It is not largesse to give much from riches that are more than necessary, but rather to give even if you have little.

Sometimes it is also used to mean “and”, as in:

47:4	So when you come against the deniers, then behead them (kill them), and when you overwhelm (conquer) them...	لَيْسَ الْعَطَاءُ مِنَ الْقُضُولِ سَمَاخَةً حَتَّى تَجُودَ وَ مَا لَدَيْكَ قَلِيلٌ
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No doubt that “حَتَّى” (*hatta*) here may mean until, but ‘and’ also gives the requisite meaning.

Sometimes it is used only to begin talking, as:

27:18	however, when they came to the valley of the <i>namal</i> ...	فَإِذَا لَقِيتُمْ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا فَصَرْبَ الرِّقَابِ حَتَّىٰ إِذَا أَخْتَضَوْهُم
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Here “حَتَّى” (*hatta*) is starting a completely new topic which has no connection with the previous talk.

H-Th-Th ح ث ث

“حَظَّ” (*hassa*), “يَحْظُّ” (*yuhusso*), “حَظًّا” (*hassan*): to hurry, to continuously ask to hurry up.
 “حَظَّ عَلَيْهِ” (*hassahu alai*): to instigate
 “الْحَظِيبُ” (*al-haseeso*): speedy, swift in one’s work {*T, M*}.

The Quran says about night and day:

7:54	the day follows the night very swiftly	بَطْلَبُهُ حَظِيئًا
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Hariri with reference to *Khalil* has written that “حَظَّ” (*hassun*) and “حَظْنٌ” (*hazzun*) are alternate words. The only difference is that “حَظَّ” (*hassun*) means to ask to make haste and to instigate, while “حَظْنٌ” (*hazzun*) means to persuade and ask to make haste {*T, M*}.

H-J-B ح ج ب

“حَبَبَ” (*hajib*), “يَحْجِبُ” (*yahjeeb*): to cover, to hide.
 “الْحِجَابُ” (*al-hijaab*): the thing that is used as a veil {*T*}.

7:76	there will be veil between the two	وَبَيْنَهُمَا حِجَابٌ
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But *Raghib* writes that it means an obstruction that obstructs one thing from getting to another: This means that punishment meted out to those in the state of *Jahannum* will not reach those who are in the state of *Jannah*. And the dwellers of *Jahannum* will not be able to partake of the pleasures of *Jannah*. Here it means to deprive.

Surah *At-Tatfeef* says:

83:15	They will be deprived of Allah’s blessings during this time. (due to their (bad) deeds)	لَهُمْ عَنْ رَحْمَةِ رَبِّهِمْ يَوْمَئِذٍ لَمَحْجُوبُونَ
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Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan has written that words in which “ح” (*hah*) and “ج” (*jeem*) comes together, indicate to the meaning of stopping or negating.

“الْحَاجِبُ مِنَ الشَّمْسِ وَالْقَمَرِ” (*al-haajib minash shamsi wal qamar*): the corner of the sun or moon which appears first {*T*}.

“الْحَجُّ” (*al-hajj*): to intend, to decide.
 “حَجَّتُ فُلَانًا” (*hajajto fulanan*): I intended for it.
 “الْحِجَّةُ” (*al-hijjah*): one year {T, M}.
 “حَجَجٌ” (*hijaj*) is the plural form.

Some scholars say that it means to decide about some respectable thing or to decide with a majority {T, M}. This is why intending to head for *Mecca* has been called “حَجٌّ” (*hajj*).

Surah *Al-Qasas* says:

28:27	eight years	عَمَى حَجَجٌ
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“الْحَجُّ” (*al-hajj*) also means to prevent.
 “حَجَّهُ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ” (*hajjahu unish shaiyi*): stopped him from (doing) it.
 “الْمُحَاجَّةُ” (*muhajjah*) has been lead to mean “to quarrel” {T, M}.

Each one of the quarrelling party tries to stop the other from his intentions.

The Quran says:

3:19	if they stop you from what you intend	فَإِنْ حَاجُّوكُمْ
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Also see 6:81.

“حُجَّةٌ” (*hujjah*): reasoning.

Muheet says that reasoning is called “بَيِّنَةٌ” (*bayyannah*) because it makes the thing clear and distinct and “حُجَّةٌ” (*hujjah*) leads to victory over the opponent.
 In surah *Anaam*, the Quranic reasoning and orders are called “الْحُجَّةُ الْبَالِغَةُ” (*al-hujjatul baalegha*) in 6:150.

For the pilgrimage at *Kaaba* the word “حَجٌّ” (*hajj*) is used in 2:196.
 In 3:96, the same thing has been called “حُجُّ الْبَيْتِ” (*hijj-ul-bait*).
 “الْحَاجُّ” (*al-hajjo*) is one who performs “حَجٌّ” (*hajj*).

“حَجٌّ” (*hajj*) is the universal gathering of the Islamic world, and is held in the center of this nation, so that solutions to their collective problems are sought in the light of the Quran. In this way this nation is able to see the benefits with their own eyes.

22:28	so that they see what is to their benefits in material (physical) form	لِيَشْهَدُوا مَنَافِعَ لَهُمْ
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For the establishment of a system, centralized gatherings are very important. It is interesting to note that the Quran gave a system of consultation, as stated in 42:38, and a gathering so that when the world was in the grip of kingships and when the world thought that they were “God’s gift to Mankind” and when it thought that the kings had the Divine right.

From the local congregation of prayers to the universal congregation of *Hajj*, the purpose is to establish the Quranic system and solve problems for mankind. For more details see heading *Qibla*.

“حَجَرٌ” (*hajar*): stone.
 “أَحْجَارٌ” (*ahjaar*) or “حِجَارَةٌ” (*hijaar*) is the plural form.
 “الْحَجْرُ” (*al-hujr*), “الْحِجْرُ” (*al-hijr*), “الْحَجَرُ” (*al-hajr*): to stop from, to prevent, to protect.
 “حِجْرًا مَحْجُورًا” (*hijran mahjoora*) as used in 25:54 means something that stops, a stopper, a barricade.
 “حُجْرَةٌ” (*hajra*): a camels’ enclosure, a room. “حُجْرَاتٌ” (*hujraat*) is its plural.
 “الْحِجْرُ” (*al-hijr*): the intellect that prevents man (from doing something harmful). 89:5

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that words in which “ح” (*hah*) and “ج” (*jeem*) appear together give the meaning of preventing from, or stopping from something.

“حِجْرٌ” (*hijr*) was also the name of the dwellings of the nation **Samood**, because these dwellings were carved out in mountains.

“خَنْجَرَةٌ” (*hanjarah*): the throat. Its plural form is “خَنَاجِرٌ” (*hanajir*) as used in 40:18, 33:10.
 “حَجَرٌ” (*hajar*): gold and silver, and a very aware and clever man as well.

Quran says about “النَّارُ” (*an-naar*):

2:25	Its fuel is humans and stones	وَقُودُهَا النَّاسُ وَالْحِجَارَةُ
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Raghib says it means people who are so adamant or whose hearts are as hard as stone. About the same people it is said a little further ahead:

2:74	Then your hearts (attitudes) hardened, so they became hard as stones or even harder. (or that their development capabilities had stopped)	ثُمَّ قَسَتْ قُلُوبُكُمْ مِّنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ فَهِيَ كَالْحِجَارَةِ أَوْ أَشَدُّ قَسْوَةً
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“النَّاسُ” (*an-naas*) could also mean the commoners who follow the elite of the society, and “الْحِجَارَةُ” (*al-hijarah*) means those clever people who as leaders make the simple folks follow them. That is, those who traverse the wrong path, the leaders and their followers both, will go to state of **Jahannum**. This is supported by other verses of the Quran, like 14:21, 33:67. If it is taken to mean gold and silver, then it would mean capital worship which gives birth to a hellish society. Surah **Tauba** says that if people keep collecting gold and silver (wealth) and do not use it for the welfare of humanity, then that gold and silver will be heated in the fire of **Jahannum** and be branded on their foreheads and backs. (9:34-35).

As such, the fuel of **Jahannum** is the capitalists and their wealth which they do not use for the benefit of mankind but for their own personal gains. On the other hand, if in 2:25 the meaning of “النَّارُ” (*an-naar*) is taken to mean battle (see heading N-W-R), and then “الْحِجَارَةُ” (*al-hijarah*) would mean the stoning which in those days was done against the opponents (as in 105:4). That would mean that since you do not decide on the basis of knowledge and intellect, then it would mean battle, which is waged by Man and inflamed by the stones which are thrown against the opponents. This can mean battle between the **Momins** and the opponents or between the opponents themselves. (See 6:65, 6:130, 27:82-83). The supporters of Allah’s laws have to go to in war in order to eradicate war from this world once for all.

Surah **Al-Anaam** says “حِجْرٌ لَا يَطْعَمُهَا” (*hijrunla yatamoja*) in 6:139, which means forbidden, which is not permitted ordinarily to eat.

“حُجُورٌ” (*hujoor*) means to protect. “حِجْرٌ” (*hijr*) means ‘lap’.

“حَجَرَةٌ” (*hajazah*), “يَحْجُرُهُ” (*yah-jozuhu*), “حَجَارَةٌ” (*hijarah*) means to stop, to prevent.
 “حَجَرَ الْبَعِيرَ” (*haja-zal bayeer*) means to make a camel sit and tie its lower legs with a rope and tie its waist with the same rope so that it cannot move and its wound on its back can be treated.
 “الْحِجَارُ” (*al-hijaaaz*) is the rope with which the camel is Thus, bound.
 “حِجَازٌ” (*hijaaaz*) is called so, because this place is situated between *Najaf* and *Tuhama* and is serves as a barrier. {T, R, M}
 “الْحَجْرُ” (*al-hajzo*) means to build an obstruction or border between two things {L}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be an obstruction or barrier.

The Quran says “حَاجِرًا” (*haajizan*) in 27:61. At another place it says “حَاجِزِينَ” (*haajizeen*) in 69:47. These words mean to prevent or stop from something.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that words in which “ح” (*hah*) and “ج” (*jeem*) appear together give the meaning of preventing from, or stopping from something.

“الْحَدَبُ” (*al-hadab*) means the stomach and chest, to cave in, and the hunch on the back to jut out.
 “حَدَبَ يَحْدَبُ حَدَبًا” (*hadiba yah-dabun hadaba*) means to be a hunch back.
 “الْحَدَبُ” (*al-hadab*) means high land, plateau, and the hard and high part of land {M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be high or lofty.

The Quran says about *Yajjoj Majjoj*:

21:96	they will jump out very fast from the plateau	وَهُمْ مِنْ كُلِّ حَدَابٍ يَنْسِلُونَ
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For details see the word *Yajjoj* in the heading (A-J-J).

“الْحَدِيثُ” (*al-hadees*): is the opposite of ancient, something new.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to come into existence from oblivion.

“حَوَادِثُ” (*hawadis*) means new events that keep coming to the fore, or keep happening.
 “حَدِيثُ السِّنِّ” (*hadisus-sin*) means young man.
 “أَحْدَثَهُ” (*ahdasa*): he did something (which was never done before).
 “أَحْدَثْتُ” (*ahdaas*): to bring into existence.
 “الْمُحَدِّثُ” (*al-muhaddas*): honest and truthful man
 “الْمُحَدِّثُ” (*al-muhaddis*): someone who relates *hadees* {T}.
 “مُحَدَّثٌ” (*mohdas*) means unprecedented {M}.

It means something that comes into existence for the first time, unparalleled. It also means something that has not happened too long ago.

Quran has used the word “مُحَدَّثٌ” (*mohdis*) in these meanings in 21:2, 26:4.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:70	let me initiate and talk first	أُحْدِثْ لَكَ
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Surah **Taha** says about the Quran:

20:113	Or so that they may think of it.	أَوْ يُخَدِّثُ هُمْ ذِكْرًا
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It can also mean that it will grant loftiness to those people. See heading (Dh-K-R). And also that it will bring the historical events of universal nations which will awaken their capacities to comprehend.

In both cases the meaning of the word “إِخْدَاطٌ” (*ihdaas*) is to bring into existence.

Surah **Az-Zuhaa** says:

93:11	you keep propagating your Sustainer's blessings	وَأَمَّا بِنِعْمَةِ رَبِّكَ فَحَدِّثْ
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Here “تَحْدِثُ” (*hadees*) means common propagation.

“أَحَادِيثُ” (*ahadees*) is the plural form of “حَدِيثُ” (*hadees*) which can mean tales, historical records as in 12:6. It has also been used for tales in 23:44.

Ibn Faris says that “حَدَثَ” (*hadas*) means for something to come into existence, out of non-present state.

This leads to “الْحَدِيثُ” (*al-hadees*) because it leads to another thing that is stories galore.

In the Islamic law, “الْحَدِيثُ” (*al-hadees*) means any speech or act which has been attributed to Allah's messenger. The meaning of “حَدِيثُ” (*hadees*) is quite extensive, but we have briefly dealt with it here.

Faraa says that “أَحَادِيثُ” (*ahahdeesa*) is the plural of “أُحْدُوْتُهُ” (*uhdoosa*) which is possible, but later it became the plural of “حَدِيثُ” (*hadees*).

H-D-D

ح د د

“الْحَدُّ” (*al-hudd*): the actual meanings of this root are to prevent or stop from something {M}.

“حَدَّ الرَّجُلَ عَنِ الْأَمْرِ” (*huddar rajula unil amr*): stopped that man from (doing) it.

“حَدَدْتُ فُلَانًا عَنِ الشَّرِّ” (*ha-dadto fulanan unish shiir*): I stopped him from something bad.

“الْحَدَدُ” (*al-hadad*): obstruction.

“هَذَا أَمْرٌ حَدَدٌ” (*haazarun hadad*): this is a forbidden act.

“الْحُدُ” (*al-hudd*): to distinguish a thing from the other, also something which becomes a barrier between two things so that one does not merge into the other, or so that one thing does not reach the other.

“الْحَدِيدُ” (*al-hadeed*): “iron”, because due to its hardness it becomes a barrier (especially to enemies). Also a sharp object or which goes through and though.

“حَدَّ” (*hudd*): to sharpen.

“الْمُحَادَّةُ” (*al-muhad'da*): infighting; to oppose each other {M}.

It actually means to prevent or stop one another from something.

Surah **Al-Ahzaab** has used “بِالسِّنِّ حَدَادٍ” (*bi al-sinatin hidaad*) ‘from sharp tongues’.

“حَدَادٌ” (*hidaad*) is the plural of “حَدِيدٌ” (*hadeed*) as used in 33:19.

Surah **Qaf** says “فَبَصَرُكَ الْيَوْمَ حَدِيدٌ” (*fa basrokal yauma hadeed*) in 50:22. It means sight that can see through the covers that are covering the truth. This is about the time of the result when eyes will be so sharp as to see the results behind the deeds.

Surah “الحديد” (*al-hadeed*) tells us to establish Allah's law, and uses the word “حَدِيدٌ” (*hadeed*) i.e. the sword or force.

Surah **Al-Mujadlah** says:

58:5	resist those who obstruct the establishing of Allah's laws and his messenger	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يُخَادُّونَ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ
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For the laws of Allah, the Quran mentions a phrase at several places, like in:

2:187	these are Allah's limits, do not go near them	تِلْكَ حُدُودُ اللَّهِ
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Calling Allah's laws as "حُدُودُ اللَّهِ" (*hudood-allah*) points to a very big reality. The Quran has generally given the orders in principle, and left it to the human beings to formulate sub laws according to the need of the times under those principles. Quranic principles will remain unchanged, but the laws under them, will change as the times change. Thus, Man has full liberty under the unchanging principles, just as the team in a game has full liberty within certain rules. Thus, Man is given a system by the Quran, in which he fulfills both, the unchanging basic principles and the changing sub-laws. This does not leave him completely unbridled or impose restrictions that curtail his freedom totally.

This is the purpose of "حُدُودُ اللَّهِ" (*hudood-allah*). But we have strayed away from the truth and formulated rigid laws which have made Islam a collection of outdated and rigid laws instead of the living movement that it is.

And which cannot be compatible with modern times. Complete freedom under few limitations. This is the way of life given to us by the Quran. "حُدُودُ اللَّهِ" (*hudood-allah*) are the last limits of Allah's law which should not be transgressed.

H-D-Q ح د ق

"الْحَدَقَةُ" (*al-hadaqah*): the blackness of the eye which surrounds the pupil.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for one thing to surround, encompass another.

"حَدَقُوا بِهِ" (*hadaqu bihi yahaqoon*): they surrounded him.

"أَحَدَقَ بِهِ" (*ahdaq behi*) is anything which encloses another.

"حَدِيقَةٍ" (*hadeeqa*) means the ditch in the valley where water gets collected.

"حَدِيقَةٍ" (*hadeeqa*) is also the garden with a surrounding wall. Without the wall, it is not called "حَدِيقَةٍ" (*hadeeqah*), and in addition this garden needs to grow grass. If there is no grass, then such a garden is called "رَوْضَةً" (*rozah*) {T, R, M}.

"حَدَائِقُ" (*hada-iq*) is the plural of "حَدِيقَةٍ" (*hadeeqah*) {T, R, M}.

The Quran says "حَدَائِقُ ذَاتَ بَهْجَةٍ" (*hadayiqah zaata bahjah*) which means delightful gardens. Here it means ordinary gardens without walls.

H-Dh-R ح ذ ر

"حَذَرٌ" (*hizr*), "حَذَرٌ" (*hazar*) is to avoid something which frightens, to be careful, to be cautious.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be aware, and avoid.

"رَجُلٌ حَذِرٌ" (*rajulun hazar*): a person who lies awake as is wary.

"إِبْنُ أَحْذَارٍ" (*ibnu ahaar*): the one person who is extremely cautious {T, M}.

"حَذَارٍ حَذَارٍ" (*hazari hazari*): caution.

"الْحَازِرُ" (*al-hazir*): a person who is armed and ready for battle {T, R, M}.

"حَازِرُونَ" (*haazeroon*): the plural form of "الْحَازِرُ" (*al-hazir*).

The Quran says:

26:56	armed armies	وَأَنَّا لَجَمِيعٌ حَازِرُونَ
17:57	Sustainer's <i>azaab</i> (the results of bad deeds) is something to be aware of	إِنَّ عَذَابَ رَبِّكَ كَانَ مَحْذُورًا

Surah **Baqrah** says “فَاحْذَرُوهُ” (*faahzuruhu*) in 2:235 which means to observe the laws of Allah.

Surah **Al-Zumr** says about a **Momin**:

39:9	he keeps the life of the Hereafter in mind	يَحْذَرُ الْآخِرَةَ
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Surah **Al-Ma'ida** uses “فَاحْذَرُوهُ” (*fakhzohu*) against “فَاحْذَرُوهُ” (*faahzuro*) (5:41) which means “to avoid”.
 Surah **Al-Baqrah** says “حَذَرَ الْمَوْتِ” (*hazarul maut*) in 2:243, 2:19, which means “to avoid or escape death”.
 Surah **An-Nisa** says “خُذُوا حَذْرَكُمْ” (*khuzohazrakum*) which includes all precautions.

“حَذَرَهُ تَحْذِيرًا” (*hazzarahu taeera*): alerted him, warned him.

“حَذَرَهُ مِنْ أَمْرٍ” (*hazzarahu min amrin*), or “حَذَرَهُ الْأَمْرَ” (*hazzarahu-lamra*): He told him to be aware of that matter.

The Quran says:

3:28	Allah tells you to be aware of the results of the natural outcome.	يُحَذِّرُكُمُ اللَّهُ نَفْسَهُ
17:57	verily your Sustainer's punishment is something to be cautious about	إِنَّ عَذَابَ رَبِّكَ كَانَ مَحْذُورًا

H-R-B ح ر ب

Muheet says “الْحَرْبُ” (*al-harb*) has basic meaning of desolation, destruction and waste.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan has written that words, in which “ح” (*ha*) and “ر” (*ra*) appear together, contain the meanings of hardness and hard work.

Ibn Faris writes that its basic meaning is to snatch, and this word is the opposite of peace. In other words this word means to fight.

“حَارَبَهُ” (*haraba*) means to fight and to rebel {T}.

The Quran says:

9:107	For those who rebel against Allah and his messenger	لِمَنْ حَارَبَ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ
5:33	These are those who rebel against Allah and his messenger	الَّذِينَ يُحَارِبُونَ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ

“حَرْبٌ” (*hurb*) means battle, war as used in 2:279.

“الْمِحْرَابُ” (*al-mihraab*): upper floor, high place, center, and palace.

Kitabal Ashqaaq says that such high places are built for battles.

“مَحَارِبُ بَنِي إِسْرَءِيلَ” (*mahareebo Bani Israel*): the mosques of **Bani Israel** in which they used to meet to consult about battles etc. {T}

The Quran too while telling Muslims to establish the system of prayer mentions mutual consultation 42:38. That is, they solve their problems with mutual consultations. This clearly shows the connections between mosques and consultation.

But it seems that “مِحْرَابُ” (*mihraab*) was also the place where sacrifices were made.

About **Zakariya** it is said:

3:38	he was engaged in <i>salah</i> in the sacrificial place	هُوَ قَائِمٌ يُصَلِّي فِي الْمِحْرَابِ
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Surah **Saba** says in 32:13 that “مَحَارِبُ” (*mahareeb*) used to be made for **Suleman** (Solomon). This could also mean strong fortresses and palaces or mosques.

“الْحَرْثُ” (*al-hars*) basically means to earn. Later this word became common as meaning to work on land. “حَرْثٌ” (*hars*), as such, means to do farming, since it entails hard labour along with the faculties of the mind.

“حَرْثَ الشَّيْءِ” (*harsash shaiyi*) Hence, means that he gained expertise in it.

“الْحَرْثُ” (*al-hars*) also means to stoke the fire to make it burn more brightly.

“الْمِحْرَاثُ” (*al-mihraas*) is the wooden poker used to stoke the fire {*T, M*}.

Quran has also called women as “حَرْثٌ” (*hars*) (cultivation, fields) in 2:223, because they are the basic means of the perpetuation of the human race. This also shows that the Quran uses this word for sexual intercourse between husband and wife which is perpetuation of the human race. For details see headings (*H-Sd-N*) and (*S-F-H*).

In surah *Waqia* “تَحْرُثُونَ” (*tahrosoon*) is used in 59:63 which means to sow seeds (in the earth), and then “تَزْرَعُونَ” (*tazra-oon*) in 56:63 which means to make the crop grow from the land.

“حَرْثٌ” (*hars*) is in Man’s own power, but “زَرْعٌ” (*zara*) happens according to Allah’s law. Man can well sow the seed in land but to make it grow is not within his power. This happens (growth) only according to Allah’s law. As such, whatever grows is not only man’s doing but also the gift of God. A man can only ask for compensation for his labor, but cannot be the owner of what God has done. For details see my book, *Nizaami Raboobiyyat*.

Ibn Faris says that “حَرْثَ نَاقَتِهِ” (*Harsun naaqata*) means that he weakened his she-camel, probably due to hard work.

“الْحَرْجُ” (*al-harj*) means to collect things in a manner that, a dense concentration appears. It also means where there are thick trees {*T*}.

Raghib says that from this it came to mean discomfort. It also means work which is not done whole heartedly.

“حَرَجَ الرَّجُلِ أَنْيَابَهُ” (*harajar rujolu anyaabahu*): he grinded his teeth.

“لَا حَرَاجَ عَلَيْكَ” (*la haraja alaika*): there’s no harm on you, or there is no objection against you {*M*}. From this, this word also came to mean ‘sin’.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan has written that words, in which “ح” (*ha*) and “ر” (*ra*) appear together, contain the meanings of hardness and hard work.

Surah *an-nisa* says that the characteristic of *Momineen* is that they follow Allah’s laws in such manner that:

4:65	they don’t feel any qualms about this obedience	لَا يَجِدُوا فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ حَرْجاً
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In Surah *An-Noor* this word has appeared to mean something objectionable (24:61).

Surah *Al-Hajj* says:

22:78	he has not been narrow in affairs of this way of life towards you	وَمَا جَعَلَ عَلَيْكُمْ فِي الدِّينِ مِنْ حَرَجٍ
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It may also means that it cannot be forced upon somebody.

2:256	It will be accepted gladly	لَا إِكْرَاهَ فِي الدِّينِ
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The laws which you observe in the way of life are not useless labor, but it is so that your personality becomes expanded and strong and stable.

2:286	Allah does not hold any person liable or responsible for anything except if it is not necessary to expand his personality	لَا يُكَلِّفُ اللَّهُ نَفْسًا إِلَّا وُسْعَهَا
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Remember that there is no narrowness in this way of life. This does not mean that you claim to follow this way of life but accept only those things which you find easy, and reject the things you find difficult (to do) on the plea that there is no narrowness or coercion in way of life.

As long as you are within this system, you will have to accept all its laws with equanimity. When you feel some coercion, you are out of this system. By staying within the system, you will have to follow and observe every law and rule. This is not coercion but a limitation which one observes voluntarily. That is, to accept the limitations set by this way of life is in a way agreement that one will observe the limitations imposed by the system. This is what is meant by no (narrowness) coercion in this way of life.

H-R-D ح ر د

“حَرَدَ” (*Haradah*), “يَحْرِدُ” (*yahridoh*), “حَرْدًا” (*hardah*): he intended to, he stopped him or he prevented him from.
 “الْحُرُودُ” (*al-hurudu*): to be aloof.

Ibn Faaris says it basically means to intend, to be angry, or to get to one side.

“رَجُلٌ حَارِدٌ” (*rajulun haarid*): a man who is aloof. It also means a man who is very angry.

In the Quran, it has been said about the men with the gardens (or orchard) “وَعَدُوا عَلَى حَرْدٍ قَادِرِينَ” (*wahadau ala hardin qaadereen*) in 68:28. This could mean that they were capable of completing their mission or purpose, and also that they had the power to prevent the poor from coming to their garden. The second meaning seems to gel with the context.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan has written that words, in which “ح” (*ha*) and “ر” (*ra*) appear together, contain the meanings of hardness and hard work.

H-R-R ح ر ر

“الْحَرُّ” (*al-har*), “الْحَرُورُ” (*al-haroor*), “الْحَرَارَةُ” (*al-harah*): heat.
 “الْحَرُورُ” (*al-huroor*): the heat of the sunlight.

In the Quran this word has been used opposite to “ظِلٌّ” (*Zill*) as “الْحَرِيرُ” (*al-hareer*) in 35:21.

“الْحَرِيرُ” (*al-hareer*): silken cloth, as used in 76:12 {*T*}.
 “حَرِيرٌ” (*hareer*): every thin or fine cloth {*R*}.

The actual meaning of this root is to be absolutely pure and without any pollution {*T*}.

“الْحُرُّ” (*al-hur*) is the opposite of “عَبْدٌ” (*abd*) which means “someone bound by contract”.
 “الْحُرُّ” (*al-hur*): a free man removed from a contract. It also means the best part of anything, the best horse, the best land from among ordinary land and sandy soil.

“حُرُّ كُلِّ أَرْضٍ” (*hurro kulli ardin*): the best part of any land.
 “مَا هَذَا مِنْكَ بِيْحُرٍ” (*ma haza minka bihur*): this is not your best work {*T*}.
 “حَرًّا” (*harra*), “يُحَرُّ” (*yuharro*): to be free.

“التَّحْرِيرُ” (*al-tahreero*): to free a slave man or woman.

“تَحْرِيرُ الْكِتَابِ” (*tehrirul kitaab*): though it might mean to free one’s thoughts from one’s mind and bring them on to a book, the writer of *Taj* says this means “to beautify edit the words of the book”, otherwise “to make the book better”.

“تَحْرِيرُ الْوَلَدِ” (*tehrirul walad*): to devote a child in the service of some place of worship.

Surah *Maryam* quotes her mother as saying:

3:34	whatever is in my womb, I have promised to devote to my deity	أَنْتِ نَذَرْتِ لَكَ مَا فِي بَطْنِي مُحَرَّرًا
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Here “حَرَّرَ” (*harar*) means that there is the condition in this that the child can never leave the service {*T*}. As such even today the Christian nuns have to devote their entire lives to the Church. This explains the very many allegations against *Maryam* which the Jews had leveled against her. *Maryam* had been devoted to the service of the *Kaneesa* or the holy place of the Jews. It seems that at that time *Maryam*’s mother had given her to the *Kaneesa*, celibacy was not required for the devotee. This was later formulated by the Jews, which later permeated the Christians too and is still practiced. *Maryam* defied this man-made rule and followed what God told her to do, and got married, left the holy place and began to live a normal life. This, according to the bigwigs of the Jews, was a very big crime and rebelliousness from their religion. That is why they persecuted her so. Details of this can be found in my book “*Shola e- Mastoor*”.

H-R-S

ح ر س

“حَرَسَهُ” (*harasa*), “يَحْرُسُهُ” (*yahresahu*), “يَحْرُسُوهُ” (*yahrosuhu*): he protected him.

“الْحَرَسِيُّ” (*al-harassio*): governmental guard and bodyguard.

“حَرَسَ الرَّجُلُ” (*harasur rajul*): this man committed a robbery.

“الْحَرِيسَةُ” (*al-hareesa*): stolen goods {*T*}.

The Quran says:

72:8	strict guards	حُرُوسًا شَدِيدًا
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“حَرَسَ” (*harasun*) and “حُرَّاسٌ” (*hurraas*) are the plural of “حَارِسٌ” (*haaris*): the protector or guard.

“حَرَزٌ” (*hurz*): the protection of goods.

“حَرَسٌ” (*hurs*) means the protection of a place {*R*}.

This will contain an element of strictness and labor because the letters “ح” (*ha*) and “ز” (*ra*) have appeared together. This is their particularity {*Al-ilmul khalaq*}.

H-R-Sd

ح ر ص

“الْحَرَصُ” (*al-hurs*) means to drill a hole into something, to tear something up or scrape something, like the washer beats the clothes on the stones and Thus, even tear up some clothes.

“تَوْبُ حَرِصٍ” (*saubun hareesun*) means clothes torn up this way.

“الْحَارِصَةُ” (*al-haarisa*) is the cloud which drills sort of holes into the ground with its rain, or scrapes the top surface of the earth.

“الْحَرَصَةُ” (*al-harsah*) means for animals’ teats to split so that the milk falls into the pots {*T, M*}.

In the light of these basic meanings, “حَرَصٌ” (*hirs*) means a wish (whether it is good or bad) which pierces the heart. It does not remain hidden in the heart and is often expressed. That is, a very earnest desire {*T*}.

The Quran says:

2:96	you will find that the wish to live forever is very intense in their hearts	وَلَتَجِدَنَّهُمْ أَحْرَصَ النَّاسِ عَلَى حَيَاتِهِ
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Another place, it is said about the Messenger (pbuh):

9:128	he is pained at whatever misfortune befalls you (he nurses the intense desire for your benefit)	حَرِيصٌ عَلَيْكُمْ
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Azhari says that to the Arabs “حَرِيصٌ عَلَيْكَ” (*hareesun alaik*) is the same as “حَرِيصٌ عَلَى نَفْعِكَ” (*hareesun ala naf'eka*) {T}. That is, the wish to benefit you is very intense in his heart.

H-R-Zd ح ر ض

“الْحَرَضُ” (*al-huraz*) means disorder, mutation, even if it is physical or mental. A weak and broken man who is near destruction, perhaps due to sorrow or heart break (12:85) {R}. A thing not worth considering, which has no good attributes {*Al-ilmul-khafaq*}.

“الْحَرِيزُ” (*al-hariz*): the man who is weakened by disease.

Raghib says “تَحْرِيزٌ” (*tehreez*) means “إِزَالَةُ الْحَرَضِ” (*izalatul haraz*) or to remove somebody's weakness. “مَرَّازَتْهُ” (*marraztoh*) means to remove somebody's sickness. Thus, “حَرَّضَ” (*harraz*) means to instigate someone for something which is life-giving for him and which if not done would be deadly for him.

The Quran tells the Messenger (pbuh) “وَحَرَّضِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ عَلَى الْقِتَالِ” (*wa harrazil momineena alal qitaal*) in 8:65. Ordinarily it is supposed to mean “get them ready for battle”, but it means that you remove all the weaknesses and faults from your companions so that they engage in struggle for life with gusto and manliness. This is what “وَيُزَكِّهِمْ” (*wa yuzakkih*) means in 62:2, which is to develop, to remove the weakness, something that is the first stage of this program.

H-R-F ح ر ف

“حَرْفٌ” (*harf*) means the end or corner of something, or limit.

“حَرْفُ الْجَبَلِ” (*harful jabal*) is the upper part of a mountain which juts out on one side.

“فُلَانٌ عَلَى حَرْفٍ مِنْ أَمْرِهِ” (*fulanun ala harfin min amrihi*): that man is standing on edge to go the way he finds beneficial {T}.

The Quran says:

22:11	in matters of observing Allah's laws they are on the border line (edge), if they find it beneficial to observe them, they do it, otherwise they leave it (the observance)	وَمِنَ النَّاسِ مَنْ يْعْبُدُ اللَّهَ عَلَى حَرْفٍ
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“حَرْفَ الشَّيْءِ عَنْ وَجْهِهِ” (*harafash shaiyi un wajhehi*): to turn something away from its right path, changed.

“التَّحْرِيفُ” (*al-tahreef*) means to change or amend, whether in words or figuratively.

“إِنْحِرَافٌ” (*inharaf*) means to lean to one side, to become crooked (not straight) {T}.

Quran says:

2:75	They change the word of Allah (amend it after understanding the word of Allah)	يُحَرِّفُونَهُ مِنْ بَعْدِ مَا عَقَلُوهُ
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“حَرْفَ لِعِيَالِهِ” (*harafa le iyaalehi*): he earned for his family {T}.

“الْحِرْفَةُ” (*al-hirfah*): industry or profession from which one earns.

“حَرِيفُكَ” (*hareefoka*): your companion in your profession {R}. (We use this word in meaning of opponent or enemy due to the mutual tussle between colleagues).

“الْمُحَارِفُ” (*al-muhaarif*): someone who strives very hard but is unable to earn enough for his family {R}.

“الْمُحَرِّفُ” (*al-muharrarf*): someone who has lost his goods {R}. Therefore, “تَحْرِيفٌ” (*tehreef*) would mean to argue and explain in such a way as to miss the spirit of the thing which is actually the capital (or the main point), whether this “تَحْرِيفٌ” (*tehreef*) is by changing the words or by changing the meaning. The changes which the nations with celestial Books have made are mentioned in the Quran.

4:46	they remove the sentences from their places	يُحَرِّفُونَ الْكَلِمَ عَنْ مَوَاضِعِهِ
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Also see 5:41. This is the sense of “تَحْرِيفٍ” (*tehreef*) (change of words or meaning).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:79	they write the Books themselves and say they have been sent by Allah:	يَكْتُبُونَ الْكِتَابَ بِأَيْدِيهِمْ ثُمَّ يَقُولُونَ هَذَا مِنْ عِنْدِ اللَّهِ
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This means change of words. Details about how badly the Christians and the Jews both have committed “تَحْرِيفٍ” (*tehreef*) in their holy books can be found in the first chapter *Zahrul Fisaad* of my book *Meraaji Insaaniyat*. None of their Holy Books is in its original shape anymore.

H-R-Q ح ر ق

“حَرَقَ الْحَدِيدَ بِالْمِبرَدِ” (*haraqal hadeeda bilmibrad*): filed the iron, which is the basic meaning according to *Ibn Faris*.

Since this process generates heat, it means to burn by putting in the fire.

“الْحَرَقُ” (*al-harq*): the flare of fire, or fire itself

“الْحَرِيقُ” (*al-hariqu*): fire, or to be on fire.

“الْحَرَقُ مِنَ السَّحَابِ” (*al-hariqu mis-sahab*): cloud with a lot of lightning.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:180	taste the punishment of total destruction	ذُوقُوا عَذَابَ الْخَرِيقِ
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Surah *Al-Ambia* says about *Ibrahim*:

21:68	they said “burn him”	قَالُوا خَرِّقُوهُ
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“الْحَرِيقُ” (*iharaq*) means to burn as used in 2:266.

Since “ح” (*ha*) and “ر” (*ra*) have appeared together in this word, it has the connotation of hardness and hard labor which is its particularity {*Al-ilmul-khafaq*}.

H-R-K ح ر ك

“حَرَكَ” (*harok*), “يَحْرُكُ” (*yahrok*), “حَرَكَا” (*harka*) and “حَرَكَهَ” (*harkah*): moved, showed some movement.

It is the opposite of being still, stationary.

“حَرَكْتُهُ فَتَحَرَّكَ” (*harraitohu fatah-harrak*): I moved it, so it became mobile. This is used for material things to be transferred from one place to another. Sometimes “تَحَرَّكَ كَذَا” (*taharraka kaza*) is said when there is a change in something, that is, there is some addition or subtraction in its elements.

The Messenger (pbuh) has been told in the Quran, with literal meanings that

75:16	do not move your tongue along with it, so that you take it faster:	لَا تُحْرِكْ بِهِ لِسَانَكَ لِتَعْجَلَ بِهِ
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It is generally thought that this is about the noble Quran, because at another place it is said:

30:114	Do not act on Revelation's program until the entire program is before you. (act only when the entire program is revealed before you, not before)	وَلَا تَعْجَلْ بِالْقُرْآنِ مِنْ قَبْلِ أَنْ يُقْضَىٰ إِلَيْكَ وَحْيُهُ
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But the Quran has not been mentioned before 75:16, but rather the context it about humans and their deeds. Thus, this verse begins on a new subject, if the context is to be kept in mind, then it will be understood that it is mankind which is being addressed, and the matter is about the catalogue of their deeds. See details in *Mafhum-ul- Quran*, because that is its right place.

H-R-M

ح ر م

Ibn Faaris says that the basic meaning is to forbid or stop someone from something.

“حَرَمَهُ الشَّيْءُ” (*haramahus shaiyi*), “حَرِيمًا” (*hareeman*), “حَرْمَانًا” (*hirmanan*): to stop something from, not to let something reach it.

“الْحَرَامُ” (*al-haraam*): all those things which are forbidden to do.

This is the opposite of “الْحَلَالُ” (*al-halal*) which means to open up the ropes and remove the shackles.

“أَحْرَمَ الْحَاجُّ” (*ahramal ha'ajj*): haji (one who performs *hajj*) reached a stage where some things which he could do previously were disallowed to him. This is the situation in “إِحْرَامٌ” (*ihraam*).

“الْحَرِيمُ” (*al-hareem*): anything that is haram (or forbidden), which is to be protected and supported at every place.

During the times of ignorance, it also meant all those clothes which they took off before circling the *kaaba* naked. That is, those clothes were forbidden to wear at that time.

“أَشْهُرُ الْحَرَمِ” (*ash-hurul haram*) means in the same sense those (four) months in which battle or war was forbidden {*T, M*}.

“حَرِيمُ الدَّارِ” (*hareemud daar*) also means the inside of the house which has been roped in and included in the house {*T, M*}.

“الْمَحْرُومُ” (*al-mahroom*) is one who cannot meet his needs, who has nothing left {*T, M*}.

Actually, the connotation of labor is included in it because “ح” (*ha*) and “ر” (*ra*) have appeared together, and the word they appear together in has an element of hard labor and hardness {*Al-ilmul-khafaq*}.

Therefore, its basic meaning is to stop or prevent vehemently.

“الْحَرَمَةُ” (*al-hurmah*) is anything which is not permitted to be done, the prohibition which cannot be broken, and also the responsibility which needs to be protected, that which must be done {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

6:152	Violation of those things which are a must for you is forbidden	تَعَالَوْا أَتْلُ مَا حَرَّمَ رَبِّي عَلَيْكُمْ أَلَّا تُشْرِكُوا بِهِ
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Surah *Al-Ambia* says:

21:95	nation which is destroyed due to the scheme of things is forbidden from rising again	وَحَرَامٌ عَلَى قَرْيَةٍ أَهْلَكْنَاهَا أَنَّهُمْ لَا يَرْجِعُونَ
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This means that salvation of such a nation is not possible. This is the destruction of nations which comes after the grace period, and due to which those nations can never raise again. But if this verse is taken with the verse that comes after it, and which begins with “حَتَّى” (*hatta*) which means “until” then it will mean that their renaissance is possible only when the situation described in the verse prevails. Or the verse would mean that these dwellings were only destroyed because they were deserving of punishment, as they did not come towards the laws of Allah at any cost. This means that a nation deserves annihilation when it loses the capacity to progress in accordance to the laws of Allah. In this case “حَتَّى” (*hatta*) in the next verse would be redundant.

“حُرْمٌ” (*hurum*) is the condition of prohibition, as used in 5:1.

“الْحُرْمَاتُ” (*al-hurmaat*): the things that have been forbidden (2:194).

“مَحْرُومٌ” (*mahroom*): someone who is prevented from something, as just returns for his labor (56:67). Someone who cannot meet the needs of life (51:19)

“مَحْرَمٌ” (*muharram*): that which has been declared forbidden (2:85), that which has been made respectable or that which must be respected (14:37).

Since the question of forbidden and permitted holds a very important place in religions, so much so that sometimes it is the basic difference between two religions, they must be discussed in detail.

God has created every human as a free spirit. Every man, simply by being a human being should be respected.

17:70	we have granted respect to man	وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ
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He has clearly stated that no man has the right to subjugate another.

Ibn Qutaiba has also written that in *la yarjeoon*, the *la* is additional, or the meaning of *haram* must be taken. (*Al-qartain* volume I page 134, volume II page 26). The second meaning is right that *la* cannot be taken as additional.

3:78	no man has the right, no matter he has been given the laws of Allah or power to rule or even prophet hood, to tell other human beings to obey him rather than Allah	مَا كَانَ لِبَشَرٍ أَنْ يُؤْتِيَهُ اللَّهُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْحُكْمَ وَالنَّبُوءَةَ ثُمَّ يَقُولَ لِلنَّاسِ كُونُوا عِبَاداً لِي مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ
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As such, according to the Quran, nobody has the right to curb the freedom of other human beings.

But there is need for certain limitations in life. These limitations are of different kinds.

The doctor may tell his patient not to eat meat for a certain number of days. Obviously this limitation is not obedience of someone's orders. It is a sympathetic suggestion which we can either observe or not observe. By accepting it, we will be benefited, and if we do not, then we stand to lose. We accept this limitation with grace, and it does not curb our freedom.

Our assembly is constituted of our representatives, it makes laws and the government implements them (for instance to drive on the left or right side of the road). This rule also is not obedience and is a prevention set by ourselves. This too does not curb our freedom.

But somebody says that according to Islam, the use of a certain thing is forbidden. This means that this man has imposed a restriction on millions of fellow human beings of his time, but imposes them in such a way that the violator is liable to punishment not only in this life but even in the life hereafter. Obviously for imposing such restrictions, one must do it on some competent authority. What is this authority according to the Quran?

The Quran has used the word *haram* for restriction of this nature, which is the opposite of *halal*. *Haram* means to prevent or restrict someone from something. The Quran has given distinct orders about what is *haram* and what is *halal*. The first thing it says is that all things that Allah has given humans are *halal*, except those things that are declared *haram*.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:172	O those with trust, whatever Allah has given you, eat the good things and thank Allah, if you are subservient to Him only.	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُلُوا مِنْ طَيِّبَاتِ مَا رَزَقْنَاكُمْ وَاشْكُرُوا لِلَّهِ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ إِيَّاهُ تَعْبُدُونَ
2:173	He has only forbidden you to eat dead bodies, and blood, and meat of pork and that which is attributed towards another then Allah...	إِنَّمَا حَرَّمَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْمَيْتَةَ وَالدَّمَ وَلَحْمَ الْخِنْزِيرِ وَمَا أُهِلَّ بِهِ لِغَيْرِ اللَّهِ

Here only edibles are mentioned. Surah *Al-Airaf* also mentions things we use, for instance:

7:32	Ask them who has forbidden life's adornments that He has created for His slaves? And the good things of life?	قَالَ مَنْ حَرَّمَ زِينَةَ اللَّهِ الَّتِي أَخْرَجَ لِعِبَادِهِ وَالطَّيِّبَاتِ مِنَ الرِّزْقِ-
7:33	tell them, my Sustainer has forbidden only shameless things, whether they are hidden or obvious	قُلْ إِنَّمَا حَرَّمَ رَبِّي الْفَوَاحِشَ مَا ظَهَرَ مِنْهَا وَمَا بَطَّنَ

In Surah **Al-Aam** explain it further that blood is only forbidden in its liquid state:

6:146	Flowing blood	دَمًا مَّسْفُوحًا
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These verses make it clear that:

- Only Allah has the right to declare something as forbidden.
- No one else besides Allah has the right to do this
- He has not declared any adornment as forbidden.
- Those edibles which have been declared forbidden have been detailed.

We have Thus, seen that only Allah has the right to declare something as forbidden, but Allah does not address each individual personally and Therefore, His decisions about forbidden or allowed were conveyed to the Messenger through Revelation).

Surah **Al-Anaam** says:

6:164	O, Prophet, tell them, that “whatever has revealed unto me, I don’t find anything <i>haram</i> in it, excepting that which is dead, flowing blood, and that which has been attributed to other than Allah	قُلْ لَا أَجِدُ فِي مَا أُوحِيَ إِلَيَّ مُحَرَّمًا عَلَى طَاعِمٍ يَطْعَمُهُ إِلَّا أَنْ يَكُونَ مَيْتَةً أَوْ دَمًا مَّسْفُوحًا أَوْ لَحْمَ خِنْزِيرٍ فَإِنَّهُ رِجْسٌ أَوْ فِسْقًا أُهِلَّ لِغَيْرِ اللَّهِ
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Thus, it is obvious that God himself has decided as to what is forbidden and what is not through Revelation.

Surah **Al-Hajj** says:

22:30	The four legged are allowed for you except those which have been forbidden according to the revelation which is related to you.	وَأَحَلَّتْ لَكُمْ الْأَنْعَامَ إِلَّا مَا يُنْتَلَى عَلَيْكُمْ-
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Surah **Al-Ankabut** says:

29:45	read what has been revealed to you from the Book	أُتِلْ مَا أُوحِيَ إِلَيْكَ مِنَ الْكِتَابِ
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This is the thing which is contained in the verses of surah **Aal-e-Imran**, the first part of which has been mentioned in the previous pages:

3:78	through this book, which you teach:	بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تُعَلِّمُونَ الْكِتَابَ وَبِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَدْرُسُونَ
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Surah **An-Namal** says clearly:

47:92	I have been ordered to recite (follow) the Quran	- إِنَّمَا أُمِرْتُ أَنْ أَتْلُو الْقُرْآنَ-
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From these explanations, it is obvious that only God has the right to declare something as Forbidden. Whatever was to be declared as forbidden has been mentioned in the Quran.

This makes clear as to who is the authority to declare something haram. Let us see further how the Quran has highlighted the fact that nobody except God has the authority to declare something forbidden

Surah **Al-Airaaf** says:

7:32	Tell them, who can declare things of adornment and	قُلْ مَنْ حَرَّمَ زِينَةَ اللَّهِ الَّتِي أَخْرَجَ لِعِبَادِهِ وَالطَّيِّبَاتِ مِنَ الرِّزْقِ
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	good things created by Allah for His missionaries as haram ?	
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Thus, it is clear that Allah has not given anyone the right to declare stuff as forbidden.

In this connection even the Messenger (pbuh) has been told:

66:1	O, prophet, why would you declare something as haram which Allah has declared halal for you (all)?	يَا أَيُّهَا النَّبِيُّ لِمَ تُحَرِّمُ مَا أَحَلَّ اللَّهُ لَكَ
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At this point we will not go into the matter as to what it was that the Messenger (pbuh) had forbidden for himself. We only want to say that this right has not been granted by Allah even to the Messenger (pbuh), and not only that, but even to forbid for him anything which Allah has not forbidden.

Here, a point in this connection needs to be clarified. The Quran says “طَيِّبًا” (**tayyeban**) along with the things which are **halal**. As in surah **Al-Baqrah**:

2:168	O mankind, the products of the land which have been made halal for you, eat it in a tayyab way	يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ كُلُوا مِمَّا فِي الْأَرْضِ حَلَالًا طَيِّبًا۔
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Tayyab means delightful, pure, beneficial and fine. It is not that everything that is halal must be eaten. You can select things to eat according to your taste and liking. Those which you do not like need not to be consumed. This allows for personal liking, medical use, and other particularities.

But for the Messenger (pbuh), there is caution even in terms of this allowance. That is, if **Zaid** does not like something and Therefore, does not eat it, then the effect of his decision will only affect him. But if the

Messenger (pbuh) leaves something, and leaves it like it is **haram** for him, then the effects could be far reaching. It is possible that due to simplicity or ignorance or due to excess of faithfulness, some may think that there must be some religious reason for him leaving that thing, and they may give it up altogether. In this manner, something which Allah has ordained **halal** becomes **haram** for the people. This has happened in earlier races. That is why this was specifically pointed out to our Messenger (pbuh).

The Quran says that **Yaqoob** (Jacob) had taken something to be forbidden for him alone, but the Bani Israel (the people who followed him) thought it to be God’s order, and made it **haram** for them. Till such time that when they saw that the things which the Quran mentions as **haram** do not include that thing, they raised the question as to why something which was forbidden by God earlier (according to the wrong concept of theirs) had been declared halal by the Quran.

Quran answers by saying:

3:94	All this food (which has now been declared halal for the Muslims) was also halal for Bani Israel, except which, before the revelation of the Torah, Israel or Yaqob had forbidden for himself.	كُلُّ الطَّعَامِ كَانَ حَلَالًا لِّبَنِي إِسْرَءِيلَ إِلَّا مَا حَرَّمَ اسْرَءِءِيلُ عَلَى نَفْسِهِ مِنْ قَبْلِ أَنْ تُنَزَّلَ التَّوْرَةُ
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These things were not declared by God, but by people.

Yaqob had, for some reason, made these things forbidden for him. The Jews thought since the God’s prophet had made it forbidden for him, then these must be forbidden by God. That is why it was pointed out to our Messenger that though he had left the use of something due to personal dislike or some other reason, (in the usual circumstances this is very ordinary) but it may so happen that some people, due to excessive piousness, may consider it **haram** too, like the descendants of Israel. Therefore, you must be careful in these circumstances.

This discussion will be incomplete without the real meaning of the verses of surah **al-araf**, without which the reader may be the victim of a misunderstanding.

In this surah, it is said about the real traits of the Messenger (*pbuh*):

7:157	he will declare the good and execrable things as <i>haram</i>	وَيُحِلُّ لَهُمُ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَيُحَرِّمُ عَلَيْهِمُ الْخَبَائِثَ
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This verse is believed to mean that the Messenger had the right to declare things as ***halal*** or ***haram***.

It must be first seen as to that Allah says at different places in the Quran that only Allah has the right to declare ***halal*** or ***haram***.

But surah ***Al-Ma'ida*** says:

5:87	O you, who entrust, do not make such things <i>haram</i> which Allah has made <i>halal</i> for you.	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تُحَرِّمُوا مَا أَحَلَّ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ
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This clearly states the things which Allah declare as ***halal***, should not be declared ***haram*** by people.

The same surah (***Al-Araaf***) says:

7:33	tell them that my Sustainer has only declared <i>fawahish</i> (transgression) as <i>haram</i>	قُلْ إِنَّمَا حَرَّمَ رَبِّي الْفَوَاحِشَ
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Here it has been said through the Messenger's mouth, to declare that only God can declare something for ***haram***.

Surah ***Al-Baqrah*** says:

2:274	Allah has declared <i>bai</i> (profit by trading) as <i>halal</i> and declared <i>riba</i> (profit by interest) as <i>haram</i>	وَأَحَلَّ اللَّهُ الْبَيْعَ وَحَرَّمَ الرِّبَا
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Therefore, where ever the Quran has attributed ***halal*** or ***haram*** towards the Messenger is as well revealed through Revelation, and is preserved in the Quran.

In his connection the following verse of Surah ***At-Tauba*** must be understood correctly:

9:29	Fight those who (among people of the book) do not believe in Allah and the Hereafter and do not consider forbidden that which has been declared <i>haram</i> by the Messenger.	قَاتِلُوا الَّذِينَ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ وَلَا بِالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ وَلَا يُحَرِّمُونَ مَا حَرَّمَ اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ
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From this verse it is inferred that Allah and the messengers both have the right to declare ***haram*** or ***halal***. In this verse, these words should not be taken to mean declaring something edible as ***haram***. As stated earlier, the word of ***haram*** is also used for making something compulsory.

Thus, the verse means that Allah and his messengers declare the things that are compulsory but they do not consider them compulsory. These people avoid the Islamic laws while remaining within the Islamic system. They will have to face war until they agree to live as subjects of an Islamic state.

This clarifies that according to the Quran:

- The right to declare something ***haram*** or ***halal*** is entirely up to God.
- Whatever that is declared as ***haram*** has been explained by the Quran.
- Nobody other than God has this right.

The Quran has declared it a great sin to declare something as ***haram*** which God has declared ***halal***. It has stressed that:

5:87	O you who entrust. Do not declare <i>haram</i> the good things which Allah has declared <i>halal</i> for you, and do not exceed the limit. Allah does not like those who exceed the limit.	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تُحَرِّمُوا طَيِّبَاتِ مَا أَحَلَّ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ وَلَا تَعْتَدُوا إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ الْمُعْتَدِينَ
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This means that to declare something halal or haram, for human beings, is to exceed the limit, because it has been said earlier that no human has the right to curb another man's freedom.

At another place it has been said with more emphasis:

16:116	And how your tongues utter falsely, that this is halal and that is haram, and accuse Allah for it. Do not do this.	وَلَا تَقُولُوا لِمَا تَصِفُ أَلْسِنَتُكُمُ الْكَذِبَ هَذَا حَلَالٌ وَهَذَا حَرَامٌ لِّتُفْتَرُوا عَلَى اللَّهِ الْكَذِبَ إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَفْتَرُونَ عَلَى اللَّهِ الْكَذِبَ لَا يُفْلِحُونَ
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Here the Quran has pointed out that those religious scholars who prepare a list of what is **haram** or **halal** know fully well in their hearts that nobody except Allah has the right to declare something as **haram** or **halal** (or they know that if they declare something as **haram** or **halal** on their own (without attributing it to Allah) then people will not observe them. That is why they say that all this is according to Allah's law. Thus, they attribute such things to Allah which He has never said. This is fabrication, falsehood, great allegation.

About such people it is said:

10:59	Say: have you pondered that you declare haram or halal from the sustenance which Allah has created for you? Ask them if Allah has permitted them to do so, or dis they make these allegations to Allah?	قُلْ أَرَأَيْتُمْ مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ مِنْ رِزْقٍ فَجَعَلْتُمْ مِنْهُ حَرَاماً وَحَلالاً قُلْ اللَّهُ آذَنَ لَكُمْ أَمْ عَلَى اللَّهِ تَفْتَرُونَ
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The Quran says that no man has been given the right to declare something for being **halal** or **haram**. Anyone who does such a thing casts allegations upon Allah.

The Quran also tells us that many things which are **halal** (for us Muslims) were declared **haram** for the Jews as a punishment.

The Quran says:

6:147	And we had declared haram all animals with nails for the Jews and the fat of cows and goats too, except that stuck to their backs, or intestines or bones. This was Our punishment for them for rebelling (from His laws).	وَعَلَى الَّذِينَ هَادُوا حَرَامًا كُلَّ ذِي ظُفْرٍ--- ذَلِكَ حَزِينُهُمْ يَبْغِيهِمْ
4:160	For the transgression of the Jews, We had declared some of the good things as haram for them	فَإِظْلَمَ مِنَ الَّذِينَ هَادُوا حَرَامًا عَلَيْهِمْ طَيِّبَاتٍ أُحِلَّتْ لَهُمْ

The details of their transgressions follow, as punishment for which many things were declared **haram** for them. Surah **An-Nahal** says this was not oppression on them from Allah, but they had oppressed themselves by becoming deserving of this punishment (16:118). This clarifies that to declare things as **haram** which have not been so declared by Allah is to punish people for no reason.

In order to relieve the Jews from this punishment, **Isa** (Jesus) made his advent. He said that the purpose of his coming as a Messenger was this very thing:

3:49	so that I can make some things halal which have been declared haram for you	أُحِلَّ لَكُمْ بَعْضَ الَّذِي هُرِّمَ عَلَيْكُمْ
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The Jews opposed **Isa** and Thus, became more deserving of punishment than ever. After that **Muhammed** was sent, and the purpose of sending him as a prophet is mentioned by Allah as:

7:156	He will make the good things halal for them and the bad things haram	وَجِئِلْ لَهُمُ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَ يُحَرِّمْ عَلَيْهِمُ الْخَبَائِثَ
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But they defied this Messenger too, and Thus, preferred to be kept captive by those inhibitions (by opposing this Messenger as well) and are still in these chains.

Those with the books had prepared lists of ***haram*** and ***halal*** according to their religious leaders, for which they had no authentication from Allah. The ***mushrekeen*** (those who followed others than Allah as well), had some traditions about ***haram*** and ***halal***, and they followed them although they were based on mere superstition. The Quran opposed them too. They used to believe that this animal among the four-legged was ***haram***, that crop was ***haram***, that once a specific animal was permitted for riding (6:139), that thing is ***halal*** for the men but not for women (6:140), so and so progeny of camel is ***haram***, so and so calves are ***haram*** (6:144). They were told that those lists were all “compiled by your forefathers” (6:149). You attribute them towards Allah without any reason (6:141). Then they were challenged that if they were right then they should produce witnesses to back their claims (6:151).

These discussions make it clear that there is no other authority than Allah to declare ***haram*** or ***halal***.

Aside from edibles, the Quran has also mentioned in detail the relationships which are ***halal*** or ***haram***. This has been mentioned in surah ***An-Nisa***, verses 12 to 24. This is the Quranic version of ***halal*** and ***haram***, and for something to be declared ***halal*** or ***haram***, Quranic authority is essential. It may be mentioned, that the (true) Islamic state, due to some emergency or some expediency declares something as prohibited for a limited period.

For instance during the rainy season, the health officer may declare that the use of figs etc. is forbidden or during a war the government orders that something is forbidden for civil use because the army’s need is greater. But it is obvious that such limitation is for a limited time period only, and declaring something as ***haram*** for all times is quite different because nothing can be declared ***haram*** by anyone except God. See heading (***H-L-L***) and (***N-Ain-M***), as well for more details.

H-R-Y

ح ر ی

“التَّحَرُّیُّ” (***at-tahri***) means to intend to, to strive to get something, to intend to do something particularly. “تَحَرَّاهُ” (***taharrah***): he intended to do it. Some say it is to strive to get the good things {***T***}.

The Quran says:

72:14	these are the people who have decided honorably to receive guidance	فَأُولَٰئِكَ نَحْنُ رَشَدًا
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Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are nearness, or intent, temperature, to return or to lessen.

“حَرَاءُ” (***hiraa***) was a mountain in Mecca city which ***Muhammed*** (pbuh) is said to visit (to receive guidance) before prophet hood {***T***}. This is only mentioned historically, but the Quran says nothing about it. The Quran says only that before prophet hood, ***Muhammed*** (pbuh) was in search for the truth and guidance. See heading (***Zd-L-L***).

H-Z-B

ح ز ب

“الْحِزْبُ” (***al-hizb***): the turn to drink, people’s group or party. The plural is “أَحْزَابُ” (***aaab***).

Rabhib says that it means the condition where the feelings and acts of the people in the group or party are similar, even if they have never met each other. ***Raghib*** also says that there is also the condition that there is hardness and intensity among those people. This is why the Quran mentions two groups i.e. “حِزْبُ اللَّهِ” (***hizbullah***) (8:22) and “حِزْبُ الشَّيْطَانِ” (***hizbush shaitan***) (58:19).

Hizbullah are those people who are strictly observant of Allah’s laws, no matter in which part of the world they may be, and ***Hizbush shaitaan*** (the opposing party) are those who live according to contradictory laws to Allah’s, no matter which nation or country they belong to. The Quran formulates nations on the basis of life or purpose of life and not on the basis of country, race and language.

In surah *Momin* the parties which opposed Allah's messengers have been called "الْأَحْزَابُ" (*al-ahzaab*). In surah *al-aaab*, "الْأَحْزَابُ" (*al-aaab*) are those parties which together fought against Allah's Messenger (40:30).

The Quran has termed sectarianism as *shirk* (that is the highest sin i.e. to worship others along with Allah). Because it then so happens that:

32:32	every group thinks that it is on the right path (and all the other sects are on the wrong path)	كُلُّ حِزْبٍ بِمَا لَدَيْهِمْ فَرِحُونَ
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By saying "كُلُّ حِزْبٍ" (*kullo hizbin*) (all groups), the Quran has clarified that when there are sects within this way of life, than it is wrong to assume that any one sect is right and all the others wrong. The very existence of sects is *shirk* to the Quran (30:32). As long as there is true *Deen* (Islamic system) there can be no sects within it. When that system is no longer present, then this way of life becomes an individual thing and the formation of sects is inevitable. To remove sects, there is only one way, which is the establishment of a truly Islamic system. Other than this, there is no way to get out of this *shirk*.

H-Z-N ح ز ن

"حَزَنٌ" (*huzn*): this is a composite word and is used for every misfortune that may befall a human being, including economic troubles form a great part of this misfortune.

"حَزَانَةُ الرَّجُلِ" (*hazanatur rajul*): those family members whose pain is felt by a man and whom he fends for {T}.

Tajul Uroos says that in surah *Faatir's* verse 35: 34, the word "حَزَنٌ" (*hazan*) means the worry about acquiring the daily bread.

Raghib says that where in the Quran, it has been said "لَا تَحْزَنْ" (*la taan*) or "لَا تَحْزَنُوا" (*la taanu*), it does not mean to not worry, because man does not have the power 'not to worry' (i.e. man cannot help worrying). It means not let those reasons be created which create "حَزَنٌ" (*huzn*). This can happen with economic wellbeing because "حَزَنٌ" (*huzn*) means the worries which arise due to financial troubles. Also "الْحَزْنُ" (*al-hazn*) means hard, stony, the opposite of which is "سَهْلٌ" (*sahl*) {T}, probably because vegetation cannot grow in such harsh soil.

Ibn Faris says that this root contains an element of hardness, harshness, and intensity.

In the heading (*Kh-W-F*) you will find that "خَوْفٌ" (*khauf*) is the worry which is due to some expected danger, (i.e. it concerns some event in the future), while "حَزَنٌ" (*huzn*) is used against this meaning. It means a sadness that is due to some event in the past, something that has passed. The situation before any loss is "خَوْفٌ" (*khauf*), and after that event this fear is no more, but sadness or "حَزَنٌ" (*huzn*) begins, or remains.

The Quran says:

3:139	Do not get sad or heartbroken. If you are those with peace, you are greater.	وَلَا تَحْزَنُوا وَلَا تَحْزَنُوا وَأَنْتُمْ الْأَعْلَوْنَ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ مُؤْمِنِينَ
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Here it has appeared against greatness and loftiness, peak, overpowering.

In the tale about *Adam*, when the life of Heaven was taken away from Adam, he was told that if he spent his life according to what was revealed, the result would be:

2:38	He will not have any <i>khauf</i> and <i>huzn</i> . (any fear or worry):	لَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ
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When this Heavenly society of Quranic laws is established in this world, then along with other comforts of life, there remains no worry on account of the economic factor. These are the basic connotation of "حَزَنٌ" (*huzn*). Also the heaven out of which *Adam* was driven out, had the particularity that nobody had to bend his back for food, clothing or housing, nor did anyone go without these (20:118 -119)

For details of these matters see headings (A-D-M), (Sh-J-R), (J-N-N).

It is obvious Therefore, that any nation which is suffering from hunger, fear, and “حَزَنٌ” (*huzn*) etc. is not obeying the laws of Allah. To live in obedience of Allah’s laws means inevitably that man’s life in this world will be successful as well as in that of the Hereafter.

In surah *Yusuf*, “حَزَنٌ” (*huzn*) has been used to mean a sadness or worry that has been born due to some past event (12:82).

“لَا تَحْزَنْ عَلَيْهِمْ” (*la tahazzan alaihim*) in 15:88 means “do not be sad for them”.

“تَحْزَنَ عَلَيْهِ” (*tahazzan alaih*) means that he was sad for it {T}.

H-S-B

ح س ب

“حَسَبَ” (*hasab*), “يَحْسُبُ” (*yahsab*), “حُسْبَانًا” (*husbana*) and “حِسَابًا” (*hisaaba*) means to count, to number.
 “حَسِبَ” (*hasibu*), “يَحْسِبُ” (*yahsabu*), “مَحْسَبَةً” (*mahsabah*), “حِسْبَانًا” (*hisbana*): to think, to have the opinion.
 “حَسْبُ” (*hasb*): that which is enough, that which suffices, after which the need ends.
 “حَسَابٌ” (*hasab*): someone who counts.
 “حُسْبَانٌ” (*husbaan*) is the plural form.
 “حَسْبُكَ دِرْهَمٌ” (*hasbuka dirham*): one dirham is enough for you.
 “حَسْبُنَا اللَّهُ” (*hasbunallah*): Allah (Allah’s laws) are enough for us (9:59). With Him there, we do not need anything else, He shall suffice to meet all our needs.
 “هَذَا بِحَسَبِ ذَا” (*haaza bihasabi za*): this is according to his need or this is sufficient for him {T, M}.
 “حَسِيبٌ” (*haseeb*): one who counts, administrator.

17:14	Read your own book, today you are accountable for yourself.	اقْرَأْ كِتَابَكَ كَفَىٰ بِنَفْسِكَ الْيَوْمَ عَلَيْكَ حَسِيبًا
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According to the scheme of things created by God, at the time of the results of one’s deeds, there is no need for any outside witness or accountant, as man’s own self is a living testimony against him.

75:14	the effects of deeds which naturally affect the person, themselves testify as to the nature of deeds done	كَفَىٰ بِنَفْسِكَ الْيَوْمَ عَلَيْكَ حَسِيبًا
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The time of the results being made known, has been called “يَوْمُ الْحِسَابِ” (*yaumul hisaab*) (the Day of Reckoning) or in 14:41 “يَوْمُ الْحَسَابِ” (*yaqumul hisaab*), the result of every deed begins to formulate as the deed is done. But they appear after a time, like the fruit which begins to take shape when the bud appears, but the fruit actually appears after some time. This is the time for their appearance of results.

6:97	We created the sun and moon for you to keep count	وَالشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ حُسْبَانًا
10:5 17:12	so that they can be used to keep track of months and years	لِتَعْلَمُوا عَدَدَ السِّنِينَ وَالْحِسَابِ

It is obvious then that there can be a calendar based on the sun’s orbiting, the lunar or solar, whichever is easier, can be used.

Surah *Kahaf* says:

18:40	He can send <i>husbaan</i> on the field (cultivation)	وَيُرْسِلْ عَلَيْهَا حُمْحَانًا مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ
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Here “حُمْحَانٌ” (*husbaan*) is generally taken to be some misfortune, i.e. some celestial catastrophe which destroys the cultivation, as rain, storm strong winds, hails, or swarm of insects {T}.

But the *Lughat Hameer* (the dictionary of *Hameer*) says it means extreme cold.

Ibn Faris says it means both, hail and swarm of locusts.

“اِحْتَسَبَ” (*ehtasab*) means to think, or have an opinion {*M*}.

The Quran says:

65:3	Allah's laws provide sustenance from places not even thought of.	وَيَرْزُقُهُ مِنْ حَيْثُ لَا يَحْتَسِبُ
2:212	Someone who desires this method gets countless sustenance from Allah.	وَاللَّهُ يَرْزُقُ مَنْ يَشَاءُ بِغَيْرِ حِسَابٍ

Raghib writes a little differently. One of them is that He gives him but does not take at all, or gives, not according to what people think, but much more than that. When society is formed according to Allah's laws, then the provision of sustenance becomes abundant and much more than common ideas.

H-S-D

ح س د

“حَسَدٌ” (*hasad*) means to scrape.

“الْحَسَدُ” (*al-hasad*): the mentality which says that whatever the other one has in possession, may be taken from him and given to me. And even if I do not get it, then may it be lost to him

“غِيْطَةٌ” (*ghibtah*) means that along with him, I too may get it, in other word, envy {*T*}.

Raghib has only added that it also includes striving for that thing.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says that the opponents due to “حَسَدٌ” (*hasad*) (jealousness) wish you to give up your trust and become a denier. So they wish that the good results of trust may be taken away from you, no matter if they gain anything from this or not (2:109).

The Quran has described jealousy as a very destructive mentality, and advised avoiding people with such mentality (113:5). This can be done through profound connection with Allah's laws.

H-S-R

ح س ر

“حَسَرَ” (*hasar*), “يَحْسِرُ” (*yahsir*): basically means to open something or scrape it or to skin.

“الْتَحْسِيرُ” (*il-la tehseer*) means for a bird to lose its feathers {*T*}. This led to its meaning of being vulnerable.

“حَسَرَ الْبَعِيرُ” (*hasaral ba-eer*): the camel was made to walk so much that it became vulnerable.

“الْحَسْرَةُ” (*al-hasrah*) Hence, means a situation in which a man becomes like a tired camel. The word has the connotation both of vulnerability and shamefulness, as well as sadness and repentance {*T*}.

Raghib says “الْحَسْرَةُ” (*al-hasrah*) means sadness and shamefulness at something's death, as if the truth has dawned upon the man and the situation in which he did something, has been removed.

That is why *Muheet* says it really means “كَشَفٌ” (*kashaf*), which means to open up.

“حَسَرَ الْبَحْرُ عَنِ السَّاحِلِ” (*hasaral bahru unis sahil*) means that the river receded from the banks and the land which was below the water, openly came into view {*T*}. This contains the elements of “كَشَفٌ” (*kashaf*) the opening, and vulnerability.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:167	Allah will unveil their deeds to them and this revealing will make them vulnerable	يُرِيهِمُ اللَّهُ أَعْمَالَهُمْ حَسَرَاتٍ عَلَيْهِمْ
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“حَسَرْتُ الْبَيْتَ” (*hasaratul bait*) means I swept the house.

“الْمِحْسَرَةُ” (*al mihsarah*) is the broom {*R*}. That means the previous verse can also mean that their deeds became totally unproductive and all they did was swept aside.

Surah *Anbia* says “لَا يَسْتَحْسِرُونَ” (*la yastahseroon*) in 21:19, which means to get tired.

Surah *Bani Israel* has used “مَلُومًا مَّحْسُورًا” (*maluman mahsoora*) in 17:29 i.e. begging situation, a condition in which all is lost, and you repent at what you did. 67:4 says “حَسِيرٌ” (*haseer*) which means getting tired and emaciated.

“التَّحَايِيرُ” (*at-tahaseer*): troubles and misfortunes.

“حَسْرَةٌ” (*hasrah*): deep sadness and shame and to repent the loss of something {T}.

“يَا حَسْرَتِي” (*ya hasrata*): “Alas!” (39:56).

H-S-S

ح س س

“الْحِسُّ” (*al-hiss*) means movement, hidden voice. This leads to “الْحَوَاسُّ” (*al-hawass*).

“أَحَسَّ” (*ahass*): that which is to feel, to be aware of {T}.

Raghib says when something becomes evident, so as to be felt, we say “أَحَسَّ” (*ahass*)

3:51	when he felt	فَلَمَّا أَحَسَّ
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“تَحَسَّنَ” (*tahass*): to find out about someone (12:87). “حَسِيْسٌ” (*hasees*): a soft sound.

21:102	They don't even hear a single sound from there	لَا يَسْمَعُونَ حَسِيْسَهَا
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“الْحِسُّ” (*al-hiss*): cold in which grass dries out.

“حَوَاسُّ الْأَرْضِ” (*hawaasul ard*): cold, hail, wind, swarm of insects and cattle which might destroy cultivation. As such the word means destruction

“الْحَاسُوْسُ” (*al-hasooos*) means drought.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:151	when you were annihilating and destroying them	إِذْ تُحْسِنُوهُمْ
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Ibn Faris says that “أَحَسَّ” (*al-hass*) also means to kill.

H-S-M

ح س م

“حَسَمَهُ” (*hasamah*), “يَحْسِمُهُ” (*yahsimoh*): he cut it off

“حَسَمَ الْعِرْقَ” (*hasam-ul-irq*): he cut the vein, and branded it with iron so that the blood did not flow off {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to cut off something at its root.

“الْحَسَامُ” (*al-husaam*): sharp cutting sword.

“الْحُسُومُ” (*al-husoom*): bad luck

Azhari says that anything which follows a thing is called “حَاسِمٌ” (*hasim*), plural of which is “حُسُومٌ” (*husoom*). Thus, it means things that come one after the other, things which keep coming continuously.

Raghib says “أَلْحَسَمُ” (*al-hasm*) means to remove the effects of something, that is, to destroy something in a way that no traces are left.

The Quran says that following about the punishment that came upon the nation of *Aad*:

69:7	The storm kept coming for seven nights and eight days.	سَخَرَهَا عَلَيْهِمْ سَئْعَ لَيَالٍ وَ ثَمَنِيَّةٍ أَيَّامٍ حُسُومًا
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“حُسُومًا” (*husooman*) here can also mean continuous, but with reference to the context, this meaning deems more appropriate that it was such a storm that removed even the traces of the *Aad* nation, or even removed them from their roots.

H-S-N

ح س ن

“الْحُسْنُ” (*al-husn*): Muheet says that “حُسْنٌ” (*husn*), or beauty means for all limbs to be in the right proportion, and generally the word “حُسَيْنٌ” (*haseen*), or beautiful, is used for things which are pleasing to the eye due to their balanced proportions. As such “حُسْنٌ” (*husn*) means the right proportion and symmetry, and is the opposite of “سُوءٌ” (*so'a*) which means unbalanced or bad.

This is why this word has come against “فَسَادٌ” (*fasaad*) in 28:77, which means disproportion. Thus, “إِحْسَانٌ” (*al-ehsaan*) means to make some proportion right. That is, if in society, there has been a decrease or insufficiency in somebody's capability or strength, to make up for it is called “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ehsaan*). See heading (Ain-D-L) in which “عَدْلٌ” (*adl*) and “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ehsaan*) have been discussed in detail.

Raghib says that “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ehsaan*) is of two types. One is to make up for the deficiencies and correct the balance, and the second to make one's own character balanced, or to create “حُسْنٌ” (*husn*) in it.

Raghib says that “عَدْلٌ” (*adl*) is to give whatever you have and take only which is your right. On the other hand “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ehsaan*) is to give more than you are required to give and take less than what is your right. This means that in *ehsaan*, the purpose is not to focus on what is due, but on creating a balance.

Surah *Al-Qasas* says that when Moses came of age and “وَأَسْتَوَىٰ” (*wastawa*), i.e. every type of balance was created in him, and then We bestowed him with knowledge and sagacity (i.e. decision power).

Later, it is said:

28:14	Thus, We reward the <i>muhsaneen</i> with the fruits of their (good) deeds.	كَذَٰلِكَ نَجْزِي الْمُحْسِنِينَ
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Here, it is obvious that “مُحْسِنِينَ” (*mohseneen*) means those who live a balanced life.

“هُوَ يُحْسِنُ الشَّيْءَ إِحْسَانًا” (*huwa yuhsinush shaiyi ehsana*): he knows it fully well {T}. Surah Yusuf relates that in prison, when two men after relating their dreams asked *Yusuf* to interpret them it is said:

12:36	We know that you are one of fully aware people	إِنَّا نَرَاكَ مِنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ
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Here “مُحْسِنِينَ” (*mohseneen*) mean people who know something very well.

The Quran has used “حَسَنَاتٌ” (*hasanaat*) as against “سَيِّئَاتٌ” (*sayye-aat*) meaning life's pleasant things, as in 7:131 and 3:119.

Surah *At-Taubah* uses “مُصِيبَةٌ” (*musibah*) against “حَسَنَةٌ” (*hasanah*) in 9:50. As such “حَسَنَةٌ” (*hasanah*) is anything which gives comfort to human beings, goods of comfort and luxury. Since this can be achieved by being in the government, it was said that We made the Bani Israel the inheritors of the East and West of Palestine, and:

7:137	Thus, the law of balance of your Sustainer was fulfilled	تَمَّتْ كَلِمَتُ رَبِّكَ الْحُسْنَىٰ
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“حُسْنَىٰ” (*husna*) is the feminine of “أَحْسَنُ” (*ahsan*).

Allah attributes are known as “الْأَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَىٰ” (*asma'al husna*) in 59:24, because Allah's persona is such that various attributes are present in it in complete balance. All attributes and in complete balance. This,

according to the Quran, is the concept of Allah, and since the purpose of man's life is to walk in His shadow, so to speak, he is nearest to Allah whose good attributes as well develop in a very balanced manner.

This is why the Quran has said:

	the attributes of Allah are certainly the attributes of Allah, and they are totally balanced	لِلَّهِ الْأَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَىٰ فَادْعُوهُ
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Therefore, call Him by those attributed, i.e. the concept of Allah is similar to the attributes that which you invoke Him with.

It is also said that:

7:180	dissociate with those who go lopsided (away from the path of balance) in any one of them (attributes)	وَدُّرُوا الَّذِينَ يُلْحِدُونَ فِي أَسْمَائِهِ
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Therefore, the required is not only to reflect upon attributes of Allah (i.e. the development of hidden capabilities of human personality), but also to balance them. The life which is without “حُسْنٌ” (*husn*) or balance is not a life which is in the Quranic mould. The purpose of life is to see how much balance you create in yourself and how much balance you contribute to the universe. In this world (outside the human personality) this “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ehsaan*) (creating balance) begins with dealing humanely with other individuals in society.

2:83	treat people in a way so that balance is created	وَقُولُوا لِلنَّاسِ حُسْنًا
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The practical way to do this is by “أَنْفَقُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ” (*anfequ fi sabi lillah*): keep the fruits of your labor open (available) for mankind and Thus, “أَحْسِنُوا” (*ahsenu*), create balance in society (2:195). This is the definition of “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ehsaan*) 2:83.

The Quran cautions that when you are asked to create *husn* or do *ehsaan*, it must not be done to get any remuneration, because:

55:60	the return for creating balance, is that balance in deed is created	هَلْ جَزَاءُ الْإِحْسَانِ إِلَّا الْإِحْسَانُ
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We generally believe that “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ehsaan*) should be returned with another *ehsaan*. For instance, a man faces hard times, he goes to somebody for help, and the other person helps him, which is assumed to be his *ehsaan*. Now the first person is on the lookout for when the other person faces bad times so that he may repay his *ehsaan*, and till that time he does so, he feels indebted. Even if he disagrees with him on a minor point, that person may recall the *ehsaan* he did on him and say “what sort of *ehsaan*-forgetting person are you?” This is the *ehsaan*, as we assume, but the above Quran ordains clearly define the difference in its use today and the real meaning.

Ehsaan means to keep on doing *ehsaan* and not even think about its compensation or return, because when *Momins* do *ehsaan* on somebody they clearly tell him:

7:6	we want no compensation, nor thanks (gratitude) from you	لَا تَرْيَدُ مِنْكُمْ جَزَاءً وَ لَا شُكْرًا
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Thus, the teachings of the Quran are aimed at creating “حُسْنٌ” (*husn*) in Man's own soul as well as in other human beings and the external universe. To make all these more beautiful, will be its own reward. That is why the Quran has said that when you feel that the balance has gone out, correct the balance. This will remove any bad effects.

23:96	Take stock of yourself first. If your personality is not balanced then try to balance it	ادْفَعْ بِالَّتِي هِيَ أَحْسَنُ السَّيِّئَةِ
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When the society loses its balance, try to rectify it. Thus, keep on beautifying the external universe through knowledge and inventions. Your efforts towards this end will be their own reward. The result of

trying to create “حُسْنُ” (*husn*) or to restore balance is that “حُسْنُ” (*husn*) or balance will ultimately be established.

Hence, the purpose of life is to maintain balance, and God’s personality is one in which “حُسْنُ” (*husn*) or balance has reached its peak.

“الْأَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَى” (*al asma ul husna*): the objective standard for man is Therefore, God’s personae for the proper development of his own faculties.

H-Sh-R

ح ش ر

“الْحَشْرُ” (*al-hashr*) means to gather people and drive them towards some direction.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to drive, to life, to get up and go.

Experts of dictionaries say that “الْحَشْرُ” (*al-hashr*) means to collect and drive.

“الْمَحْشَرُ” (*al-mahshar*), “الْمَحْشِرُ” (*al-mahshir*) is a place to gather.

Muheet says people use this word for a crowd and to create narrowness (lack of space) for each other {M}. This means such crowd or gathering which creates difficulty for others.

The Quran has also used this word to mean “to gather for war”, as in:

27:17	as per <i>Sulemans’s</i> orders, the armies were collected and taken	وَحْشِرَ لِسُلَيْمَانَ جُنُودَهُ
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And about the Jews, it is said in surah *Al-Hashr*:

52:6	Allah is He who, among those who had the Book, took the rebellious out of the houses for <i>hashr</i>	هُوَ الَّذِي أَخْرَجَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا مِنْ أَهْلِ الْكِتَابِ مِنْ دِيَارِهِمْ لِأَوَّلِ الْحَشْرِ
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This too refers to a gathering for war or exile, which was the outcome of this battle.

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says to tell these opponents:

3:11	you will be overpowered soon, and will be collected in the ground of destruction and then taken towards <i>jahannam</i>	سَتُعْلَبُونَ وَ تُحْشَرُونَ إِلَىٰ جَهَنَّمَ
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Its next 3:12 verse details the battle.

Surah *Shura* says about the Pharaoh that he sent “حَاشِرِينَ” (*haashereen*) to different cities (26:36). This means that representatives who would collect people and bring them (to him) were sent to different cities.

“الْحَشْرُ” (*al-hashr*): to sharpen the blade and to take from one place to another after collect them together, as drought gets people out of the villages and into the cities {T}.

“الْحَشْرَةُ” (*al-hashara*) means that which is hunted and is edible, i.e. which can be eaten. It also means insects. That is why “حشرات” (*hasharaat*) means insects and small animals. In the Yemen dialect, it means “saw dust” {T}.

“الْحَشْرُ” (*al-hashr*) also means death. It is also the fine part of the ear.

Surah *Tahaa* says:

20:124	and We will raise him blind on <i>yoom-ul-qiyyamah</i>	وَنَحْشُرُهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ أَعْمَى
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This means to give return for deeds. That is, the results of deeds continue to be formulated very discreetly.

“مَحْشُورَةً” (*mahshoorah*): gathered together (38:19).

50:44	it is easy for us to gather them	ذَٰلِكَ حُشْرٌ عَلَيْنَا يَسِيرٌ
46:6	And when mankind are gathered	وَإِذَا حُشِرَ النَّاسُ

In these places, the connotation of taking them somewhere along with gathering together must be borne in mind.

We generally take “حُشْرٌ” (*hashr*) to mean reckoning (after death on the Day of the Judgment), like *Aakhirah*, *qiyamah*, *sa’ah*, *bo’as* etc. These are composite terms of the Quran and mean not only to rise after death but also the renaissance of nations. As such, *Shah Waliullah* says (in *Hujjatulaahi Baligha - Kitabul Fatan*) that in Islamic (*sharia*), “حُشْرٌ” (*hashr*) has two meanings. One is the gathering or collection of people in Syria, that is, before the *Qiyamat*, this will happen when people are sparse and either due to various ceremonies or due to battle, people will gather there, and the second is to rise after death.

Wherever these words appear in the Quran, it must be noted with reference to the context whether they mean life after death, or a revolution in this world.

H-Sd-B ح ص ب

“الْحَصْبُ” (*al-hasabah*) means gravel, small stones.
“الْحَصَبُ” (*al-hasab*) means fuel, or whatever is put into the fire to make it burn brighter, as firewood.
“حَصَبٌ” (*hasab*) can be used if the fire is stoked.
“الْحَاصِبُ” (*al-hasib*): the strong wind which raises dust and gravel {T}.

The Quran says:

17:68	Send towards you a wind that raises gravel or stones	يُرْسِلْ عَلَيْكُمْ حَاصِبًا
21:98	you and your gods whom you worship other than Allah are the fuel for hell	إِنَّكُمْ وَمَا تَعْبُدُونَ مِن دُونِ اللَّهِ حَصَبٌ جَهَنَّمَ أَنتُمْ لَهَا وَارِدُونَ

Here “حَصَبٌ” (*hasab*) means fuel. The fiery wind which blew from a volcano towards the nation of *Loot* was also called “حَاصِبًا” (*haaseba*). It has a mix of both, small stones and the heat of the fire.

H-Sd-D ح ص د

“حَصَدٌ” (*hasad*) means to cut cultivated crop or plants with a shears {R}.

12:47	let the corn remain in the ear of the crop you cut	فَمَا حَصَدْتُمْ فَذَرُوهُ فِي سُنْبُلِهِ
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“حَصَادٌ” (*hasaad*): to cut the crop, as used in (6:142), or the time to cut the crop.
“الْحَصِيدُ” (*al-haseed*): the crop that is cut.

About the annihilated nations, the Quran says:

21:15	We made them motionless and quiet like the crop which has been cut.	جَعَلْنَاهُمْ حَصِيدًا خَامِدِينَ
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“أَحْصَرُ” (*al-hasr*): to stop, to imprison, to create narrowness {T}.

Raghib says that “حَصْرٌ” (*hasr*) and “إِحْصَارٌ” (*ihsaar*) are said when the stoppage is due to some visible obstruction (like if the enemy has stopped you) or if there is some internal reason (like disease which has prevented you). When the obstruction is only internal then “حَصْرٌ” (*hasr*) is used {R}.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:90	or they may come to you in the condition that their chests are constricted and hearts narrow (frustrated)	أَوْجَاءُ وَكُمُ حَصِرَتْ صُدُورُهُمْ
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“حَصِيرٌ” (*haseer*) as used in 17:8 means a prison, as well as a narrow-minded person. It also means that miser who does not drink, only due to his miserliness.

“أَلْحَصُورُ” (*al-hasoor*) as used in 3:38 means one who refrains, especially one who refrains from going to women {T}.

“حَصُورٌ” (*hasoor*) can also mean a man who has control over his libido.

“مُحَاصِرَةٌ” (*muhasarah*) means to surround the enemy and stop it.

“حَصَرَ الْقَوْمُ بِفُلَانٍ” (*hasarun qaumun bi fulani*): the nation surrounded somebody {T}.

Surah *Baqrah*'s verse “أُحْصِرُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ” (*ahsiru fi sabeelil lah*) has been explained by “لَا يَسْتَطِيعُونَ ضَرْبًا” (*la yastati-oona zarban fil ard*) in 2:273. It is about those who are stopped in a way that they cannot move, that is, their movements are restricted.

Surah *Bani Israel* states “جَهَنَّمَ” (*Jahannam*) as “حَصِيرًا” (*haseera*) in 17:8. This means a place or condition where one's development stops, or where somebody is forbidden to go forth. For the right meaning of *jahannam*, see heading *jahannam* and (J-H-M).

“أَلْحَصُّ” (*al-hass*): to shave the head so that the head is cleaned.

“أَلْحَصَاءُ مِنَ الرِّيحِ” (*al-mohassa'a minar riyah*): clean air without any dust or pollution etc.

“حَصَّ الشَّيْءُ تَحْصِيصًا وَحَصَّصَ” (*hus-hasa shaiyo tahseesnan wah hus-hus*): The thing became evident, became distinct. In other words, it was previously hidden but got clearly visible {T, R}.

“حَصَّصَ” (*hushus*) is a four-lettered word (ح ص ح ص) but we have dealt with it as three-letter sections.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:51	now the reality is clear (the reality has now become evident)	الآنَ حَصْحَصَ الْحَقُّ
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But **Muheet**, with reference to **Baizawi** says that this is from “حَصَّصَ الْبَعِيرُ” (*husasil aabeer*) which means that the camel, in order to sit down, rested his knees and chest firmly on the ground.

“حَصَّصَ الْحَقُّ” (*hus hasal haq*): the truth is proven and become well evident {M}.

“حِصَّةٌ” (*hissah*): that which is cut off from the thing itself, a part of the whole {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings include being a part, to become clear, and also for something to end or lessen.

“الْحَاصِلُ مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*al-haasilo min kulli shaiyi*): that which remains of something.

“التَّحْصِيلُ” (*at-tahseel*): whatever that is received, to separate it.

“تَحْصِيلُ” (*tahseel*) actually means to pick the kernel out of the skin, for instance wheat from chaff, or to pick out small stones from the wheat.

“تَحْصَلُ الشَّيْءُ” (*tahassala shaiyi*): the thing was collected and was proven.

“الْحَوْصَلَةُ” (*al-hauslah*): a bird's stomach {T, R}.

The Quran says:

100:1	whatever is hidden in the chest (or anywhere else) will be brought out like kernel from the skin	وَحُصِّلَ مَا فِي الصُّدُورِ
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Ibn Faris writes that “تَحْصِيلُ” (*tahseel*) means to take out gold or silver from the mine.

“الْإِحْصَانُ” (*al-ihsaan*) means to safe keep something, protect it. This is its basic meaning.

“حَصَنَ الْمَكَانَ يُحَصِّنُ” (*hasanul makanu yahsun*): for a place to be safe in a way that there is no way it can be reached, a place as safe as this, would be called “أَلْحِصْنُ” (*al-hisn*).

“حَصَّنَهُ” (*hassanahu*) and “أَحَصَّنَهُ” (*ahsanah*): he made it safe.

“أَلْحِصْنُ” (*al-hisn*): every safe place which cannot be reached, plural is “حُصُونٌ” (*husoon*) as used in 59:2.

“مُحَصَّنَةً” (*muhssana*): protected, as in 59:14.

“أَلْمِحْصَنُ” (*al-mihsun*): lock for protection.

Surah *Al-Anbia* says:

21:80	So that it keeps you safe.	لِيُحَصِّنَكُمْ
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Surah *Yusuf* says for wheat that was safe kept:

12:48	Unless that which you keep safe.	مِمَّا تُحْصِنُونَ
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“حَصَانٌ” (*hasaan*) is a woman who protects her chastity {T, R, M}. It also means a pearl (because it is safe in a clam). There are two ways a woman can be chaste. One is that she is unmarried and protects her chastity, and secondly that she gets married and belongs to only one man. Thus, she protects her chastity from other men. A chaste woman is called “مُحْصِنٌ” (*mohsin*) or “مُحْصَنٌ” (*mohsan*).

Raghib says “مُحْصِنٌ” (*mohsin*) (protector) is used when she protects her chastity in an unmarried state, while “مُحْصَنٌ” (*mohsan*) when she (who is protected) is married (and Thus, is protected by marriage). Therefore, “أَلْمُحْصِنَاتُ” (*al-mohsinaat*) mean married women.

“أَحْصَنَ” (*ahsan*) means to get married.

But *Taj-ul-Uroos*, with reference to *Johri* and *Sa'lab*, writes that chaste women are called “مُحْصِنَةٌ” (*mohsinah*) as well as “مُحْصَنَةٌ” (*mohsanah*) both. On the other hand, a married woman is only called “مُحْصِنَةٌ” (*mohsinah*).

The Quran uses “أَلْمُحْصِنَاتُ” (*al-mohsinah*) for chaste women in 24:4, which includes both married and unmarried women. As such when “مُحْصِنَةٌ” (*mohsinah*) is used, it will have to be seen with reference to the context whether it means a spinster or a chaste woman or a married woman.

This word has been used in the Quran in 5:5, 234:4, and 24:23. In surah *Nisaa* verse 4:25, this word has been used against “فَتَيَاتٍ” (*fayyaat*), where it means free women (as removed from slavery). In the same surah's verse 4:24, it has been used to mean chaste or ‘with husband’. According to the first meaning of this word, the verse would mean that all chaste women except those in your marriage are unlawful for

you. While according to the second meaning the verse would mean that all women with husbands are unlawful for you, except those slave women which you already possess. Except women with husbands who have already been excepted (60:10). Here, the meaning of women with husbands is more appropriate.

The Quran has used two words for the sexual relations between man and woman, “مُحْصِنِينَ غَيْرَ مُسَافِحِينَ” (*mohseneena ghaira musafeheen*) in 4:24.

See the detailed meaning of “سَفَحَ” (*safah*) under heading (*S-F-H*).

Here it suffices to know that it means to wash away or waste your sperm uselessly. If it is only for taking out the sperm, that is, for pleasure, or the satisfaction of sexual desire, then it is called “زنا” (*zina*) or illegal fornication. This is not permitted, and if it is intended to give the sperm a spot to stay i.e. pregnancy, and not be wasted, then it is allowed. This is called “نِكَاحَ” (*nikaah*). As such the Arabs used the word *nikaah* against *siffah*. They also used to gamble with arrows where every arrow was for a particular spot, but one arrow was extra. It had no part in play. This arrow was called “السَّفِيحَ” (*as-safeeh*) {T}. This shows what “مُحْصِنِينَ غَيْرَ مُسَافِحِينَ” (*mohseneena ghaira musafeheen*) means.

“الْمَسْفُوحُ مِنَ الزَّرْعِ” (*al-masfooh minaz zar’a*) was a cultivation whose leaves yellowed due to extreme cold and its seeds withered down {M}. In this way, the whole cultivation got lost. This too shows what the Quran means by sexual intercourse.

That is why it has called women as cultivation in 2:223 that means, a man and woman’s sexual intercourse should be “مُحْصِنِينَ” (*mohseneen*), which is to protect the responsibilities that are imposed (though willingly) on each other through marriage. This aim at the protection and perpetuation of the human race is not just sexual satisfaction, or unproductive sex. *Nikaah* for a limited period is also “سَفَحَ” (*safah*) not “إِحْصَانَ” (*ihsaan*). See also heading (*Kh-D-N*).

As to how much the nature of sexual relationships affect a society, see my book “*Letters to Tahira*”.

H-Sd-Y

ح ص ي

“الْحَصَى” (*al-hasa*): small gravel, like stones. Since the Arabs used small stones to keep count, as is done on the fingers, Therefore, “إِحْصَاءٌ” (*ihsaa*) means to count as used in 14:34. It also means to count, and procure and surround.

The Quran says:

72:28	he has counted each and every thing and surrounds it	وَأَحْصَىٰ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ عَدَدًا
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This includes the elements of counting as well as taking into protection.

Surah *Al-Muzammil* says:

73:28	he knows that you cannot have the perseverance to do it regularly	عَلِمَ أَنَّ لَكَ تُحْصُوهُ
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Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:12	has anyone of the two groups taken the period into consideration (or kept track of): or kept it in one’s control	أَيُّ الْحِزْبَيْنِ أَحْصَىٰ لِمَا لَبِئُوا أَمَدًا
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We think it is better to take the word as a past tense. *Kishaaf* has also written so.

Ibn Faris has written that its basic meaning is to abstain (from something), also to count and to have the capacity to do something with difficulty. This too means to surround and to persevere.

“حَظَرَ” (*hazar*), “يَحْظُرُ” (*yahzuru*), “حُظُورًا” (*huzura*) means to be present. It is the opposite of being absent.

“حَاضِرٌ” (*haazir*) means present.

“أَحْضَرَ الشَّيْءَ” (*ahzarash-shaiyi*): presented the thing {*T, R*}.

“حَضَرَهُ” (*hazarahu*), “أَحْضَرَهُ” (*aaraha*), “أَحْضَرَهُ” (*ahazarah*): presented him, made him present, came to him and reached {*M*}.

Ibn Faris says this root means to reach, to deliver, to make present.

“أَلْأَحْضَارُ” (*al-ihtezaaru*) means the time of death, when death becomes present.

In verse 23:98 “يَحْضُرُونَ” (*yaarooon*) means to hurt; or to do badly.

“أَلْحَضَارَةُ” (*al-hazaarato*): stay in the city, as against “بَدَاوَةٌ” (*badawah*) which means to reside in the village.

“أَلْحَاضِرَةُ” (*al-hazirah*): means green habited areas, cities, group of dwellings.

The Quran says:

2:133	when death faced <i>Yaqoob</i> (when his time to die had come)	إِذْ حَضَرَ يَعْقُوبَ الْمَوْتُ
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“حَاضِرَةُ الْبَحْرِ” (*haaziratil bahr*): to be situated on the bank of a river (7:163).

“تِجَارَةُ حَاضِرَةٍ” (*tijarato haazirah*): cash transaction or cash trade (2:282).

“مُحْضَرُونَ” (*mohzaroon*): those who were made to be present, to undergo punishment (30:16).

“مُحْتَظَرٌ” (*moh tazar*): the one who is made to be present (54:28). There will be a drinking place for whosoever the turn is, and nobody else would have besieged it.

“أَلْحَضُّ” (*al-hazz*): to instigate something.

Khalil says “أَلْحَضُّ” (*al-hazz*) means to drive and also to instigate for other things (with reference to *Ibn Faris*) “حَضَّه” (*hazzahu*), “يَحْضِضُهُ عَلَى أَمْرٍ” (*yahuzzuhu alaa amr*): to instigate someone for something.

“حَاضِيزٌ” (*hazeez*): means low land, because man goes towards a slope quite fast {*T, R*}.

The actual meaning of “حَضَّ” (*huzz*) is to drive or steer an animal towards the low or sloping land {*R*}. Later on the word came to be used to mean instigate, prompt.

The Quran says:

69:34	he does not instigate or persuade towards feeding the poor	وَلَا يُحْضِضُ عَلَى طَعَامِ الْمُسْكِينِ
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Surah *Fajar* says:

86:18	They do not motivate or instigate each other. Those who do so deny this way of life.	وَلَا يَحْضُونِ
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Also see 107:1-4. Note how deeply the Quran is linked to economics.

“الْحَطَبُ” (*al-hatab*): firewood, fuel. When alighted, this fuel will be called “وَقُودٌ” (*waqood*).
 “حَطَبَ يَحْطِبُ” (*hataba yahtib*): to collect firewood.
 “مَكَانٌ حَطِيبٌ” (*makanun hateeb*): the place where there is a lot of wood.
 “هُوَ حَاطِبُ لَيْلٍ” (*huwa haatibul lail*): he relates all sorts of things, good and bad, useful and useless, like in the darkness of the night, a collector of wood, thinking a snake to be some wood, picks it up.
 “فُلَانٌ يَحْطِبُ عَلَى فُلَانٍ” (*fulaan yahtibu alaa fulaan*): so and so man instigates people against so and so.
 “حَطَبَ فُلَانٌ بِصَاحِبِهِ” (*hatiba fulanu besahibehi*): so and so squealed against his companion.

The Quran has used “حَطَبًا” (*hatiba*) in 72: 15 to mean fuel, and **Abu Lahab's** wife has been called “حَمَّالَةٌ” (*hamma latal hatab*) in 111: 4 which may mean enmity or squalor. The meaning ‘who speaks against someone (untruthfully)’ seems to be more appropriate, or the one who increases the tools or means of opposition.

“الْحُطُّ” (*al-hutt*): the root actually means to take down from above and place it down {M}.
 “الْحُطُّ” (*alhutto*), “الْإِحْطَاطُ” (*al-ihetataat*): to unload luggage etc. from a transport as a camel or donkey or some vehicle.
 “حُطَّ فِي مَكَانٍ” (*hutta fi makan*): he got down somewhere.
 “الْمَحْطُ” (*al-mahutt*): destination, a place to stay.
 “حُطَّ الرَّجُلُ يَحُطُّ” (*hutar rajulo yahut*): he got down from above.
 “الْحُطَاءُ” (*al-hutaa-it*): man of small height {T}.

In surah **Al-Baqrah** verse 2:58 where the **Bani Israel** have been told to enter the city victoriously, it is also said “وَقُولُوا حِطَّةٌ” (*waqulu hitta*) which means to go and settle in this city, and pray that days of our wandering in the wilderness may come to an end. Let our traveling goods be unloaded and let us live comfortably.

Raghib says “حِطَّةٌ” (*hitta*) is the same as “حُطَّ عَنَّا ذُنُوبُنَا” (*hutta unna zunubana*): unload our sins from us, remove our sins from us. This too means that we may be pardoned and our days of gypsy life may be over.

“الْحُطْمُ” (*al-hatm*) means to break, no matter how. To break something dry, like the bones
 “انْحَطَمَ” (*inhatama*): that thing broke.
 “الْحِطْمَةُ” (*al-hitma*), “الْحُطَامَةُ” (*al-hutama*): whatever that breaks off a thing.
 “الْحُطِيمُ” (*al-hateem*): the part which has been left aside from the **Ka'ba**.
 “الْحُطْمَةُ” (*al-hatma*): severe drought year.
 “الْحُطْمَةُ” (*al-hutama*): camels or goats in large number who trample the crops. It also means intense fire which burns everything down to its ashes. It is also used for a shepherd who oppresses his flock.

Surah **An-Namal** says:

27:18	lest they trample you:	لَا يَحْطِمَنَّكُمْ
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Surah **Az-Zumr** says:

39:12	then He breaks into very small pieces, like something trampled upon:	ثُمَّ يَجْعَلُهُ حُطَامًا
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Surah **Al-hamzah** uses “الْحُطْمَةُ” (*al-hutamah*) for **jahannam** in 104:4, that is, the condition in which humanity is trampled down.

“حَظْرَةُ الشَّيْءِ بِحَظْرَةٍ” (*hazarhush shaiya yah-zarohu*): to stop him from something, to lock, to stop.
 “حَظْرَةُ عَلَيْكَ” (*hazarahu alaika*) is said when something becomes an obstruction between two things.
 “الْحَظِيرَةُ” (*al-hazeerah*): the boundary around a field (of crops), boundary, a circle of sorts which is made from branches of date palms etc. and dates are put inside after being picked, a camel pen etc.
 “الْحِظَارُ” (*al-hizaar*): a wall.
 “الْكَهْزِيرُ” (*al-khazeer*): also means a miser because he keeps his wealth to himself and does not open it (makes it available) for the rest of human race.
 “الْمَحْظُورُ” (*al-mahzoor*): stopped, obstructed, and prevented, one who has been stopped from receiving something {T}.

The Quran says that as per God's physical laws, worldly wealth, according to one's efforts, can be acquired by anyone who strives, whether **Kaafir** (denier) or **Momin** (believer).

17:20	God has not limited his Benevolence (to the Momin only)	مَا كَانَ عَطَاءُ رَبِّكَ مَحْظُورًا
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It has been kept open for all mankind, and there for they should be open for all. The system which puts curbs on God-given fountains of sustenance by putting them in individual ownership violates the universality of God's principles. That is why it can never succeed. This has been called “يَمْنَعُونَ الْمَاعُونَ” (*yamna-oonal ma-oon*) in 107:7 that is, the sustenance which should flow like water, has been curbed by putting dams.

Surah **Qamar** says about the destruction of the nation of **Samood**:

53:31	they became like the leftover broken pieces in an old pen (or like the sawdust which a man makes an enclosure to keep) (<i>Ibn Faris</i>).	فَكَانُوا كَهَشِيمِ الْمُحْتَظِرِ
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“الْحُظُّ” (*al-huzz*): luck, ordained part.
 “أَحْظُ فَلَانٌ” (*ahuzza falan*): that man became rich and lucky.
 “الْحَظِيزُ” (*al-hazeez*): lucky and well to do {T}.

The Quran calls a very lucky man as “زُحَّظٌ عَظِيمٌ” (*zuhazzan azeem*) in 41:35. He is the man who removes with goodness whatever that is bad, and treads steadfastly on the right path (41:34-35).

“حَفَدٌ” (*hafad*), “يَحْفَدُ” (*yahfad*): to be quick in work, to serve.
 “الْحَفْدُ وَالْحَفْدَةُ” (*alhafado walhafadah*) means servants. It is the plural of “حَافِدٌ” (*haafid*), and a “حَافِدٌ” (*haafid*) is one who does some work with alacrity and obedience {T}.

The Quran says:

16:72	he made your wives give birth to you progeny (sons) and servants as well	وَجَعَلَ لَكُم مِّنْ أَزْوَاجِكُم بَيِّنٌ وَحَفْدَةً
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Some say that “حَفَادُ الرَّجُلِ” (*hifaadur rajul*) means man's progeny. Some others say that it means relatives by law. Still some others say this means grandsons {*Lataif-ul-Lugha*}. The majority however, thinks it means servants, and the verse means that He gave birth to your progeny from your wives and created servants to serve you. This word is taken to mean grandsons because they are more sincere in service.

By servants, it is meant those who help in work, not slaves or low status citizens whom you do not even give the status of human beings.

H-F-R

ح ف ر

”حَفَرَةُ“ (*hafarash shaiya yahferuh*) means to dig. The place which is dug is called ”حُفْرَةٌ“ (*hufrah*), and with which tool you dig, is called ”مِخْفَارٌ“ (*mihfaar*) {T, R}.

”الْحَفْرَةُ“ (*al-hufra*): a dug hole {T, R} as used in 3:102.

”الْحَافِرُ“ (*al-haafir*): an animal's hooves, because when the animal walks his hooves dig the ground.

”حَافِرَةٌ“ (*haafirah*) is a road or path with landmarks.

”رَجَعْتُ عَلَى حَافِرَتِي“ (*raja'to ala haafirati*): I returned to the path I was on. That is, to return to one's former state.

Ibn Faris says it also means the first task besides digging.

Surah *An-Nazeaat* says that when they are told that their power and wealth will be lost to them and they will return to their former state when they were without it, they make fun of this.

79:10	and they say 'listen to this, they say that we will return to our former state (as if this was possible)	يَقُولُونَ ء إِنَّا لَمَرْدُودُونَ فِي الْحَاوِرَةِ
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Taj says that ”حَافِرَةٌ“ (*haafirah*) means for the last part to return to the first part. In other words, to become as you were, or to return towards life after that even your bones have become hollow, or to relive.

H-F-Ze

ح ف ظ

”حَفِظَ“ (*hafezah*), ”حَفِظًا“ (*hifzan*) means to guard, to protect {T}.

”الْحِفْظُ“ (*al-hifzo*) means the same in (37:7).

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that words in which ”ح“ (*ha*) and ”ف“ (*fa*) appear together have the connotation of collecting or gathering together.

One aspect of protection is not to let something be scattered, be divided, to keep together.

”حَافِظٌ“ (*hafiz*), ”حَفِيطٌ“ (*hafeez*): the man who is appointed to guard something, a guard {T}.

86:4	there is a guard or overseer appointed for everyone:	إِنَّ كُلَّ نَفْسٍ لَّمَّا عَلَيْهَا حَافِظٌ
11:57	my Sustainer is overseer of everything	إِنَّ رَبِّي عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ حَفِيطٌ

In surah *Qaf*, a *Momin* has also been called ”حَفِيطٌ“ (*hafeez*). It would mean one who guards or oversees Allah's laws. The plural is ”حَفَظَةٌ“ (*hafazah*).

In the Quran, this word has also been used for those celestial powers (*malaikah*) which according to Allah's law control everything (6:61).

”إِسْتَحْفَظْتُ“ (*istahfaz*): to wish for protection.

”مَحْفُوظٌ“ (*mahfooz*): kept in protection.

The Quran says:

5:44	the Book of Allah which was given to them for safekeeping: which they were required to protect:	بِمَا اسْتُخْفِفُوا مِنْ كِتَابِ اللَّهِ
21:31	We made the sky a safe roof	وَجَعَلْنَا السَّمَاءَ سَقْفًا مَحْفُوظًا

Fathal Qadeer says that it means ”مَرْفُوعاً“ (*marfoo-a*) or high. But we did not get confirmation of this in the dictionaries. Perhaps these meanings were taken with regards for protection of something, is kept so

high that it is beyond people's approach or reach, but this is only a guess. For the meaning in detail see heading (S-M-W)

Nasir says that "الْحَافِظُ" (*al-haafiz*) also means straight and clear path.

H-F-F

ح ف ف

"الْحِفَافُ" (*al-hifaaf*): the ring of hair on a bald man's head: Otherwise this word means everything which surrounds something.

"حَفَّهَ بِالشَّيْءِ" (*haffa bish shaiyi*): he surrounded him with something.

"حَفَّفَ حَوْلَهُ" (*haf-fafo haulahu*): he surrounded him {*T, M*}.

The words in which "ح" (*ha*) and "ف" (*fa*) appear together, contain the meaning of gathering together or collecting.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* talks about two orchards:

18:32	We placed date palms around them	حَفَفْنَاهُمَا بِنَخْلٍ
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Surah *Al-Zumr* says:

39:75	you will find that the <i>malaika</i> surround the sky	وَتَرَى الْمَلَائِكَةَ حَافِّينَ مِنْ حَوْلِ الْعَرْشِ
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The sky (*arsh*) is the center of the universe's control, and *malaika* are the forces which put God's program into action. All these forces work according to God's celestial control.

H-F-Y/W

ح ف ي و

"الْحَفَا" (*al-hafa*): man's or camel's foot and animals' hooves which due to excessive walking get injured or scraped, or to walk barefoot without shoes or socks.

"إِخْتَفَى" (*ihatafa*): he walked bare foot {*M*}. Since a man gets up and leaves barefoot only for some work which he deems urgently and think of as most essential, Therefore, this word is also used for intensity and exaggeration.

"حَفَى بِهِ" (*hafia behi*): treated him very kindly, respected him, and expressed pleasure at seeing him {*M*}.

"حَفَى عَنْهُ يَحْفَى" (*hafia anhu yahfaa*): to find out about someone's welfare time and again.

"أَحْفَى السُّؤَالَ" (*ahfas suwaal*): he repeated the question again and again. He asked insistently.

"الْحَفَى" (*al-hafee*): a scholar who has acquired knowledge with great endeavor or someone who can get to the bottom of things.

"اسْتَحْفَى الرَّجُلُ" (*istahfar rajul*): he found out with much effort {*M*}.

"الْحَافِي" (*al-haafi*): judge who gets to the bottom of the matter and decides the case.

"الْحَفَى" (*al-hafee*): someone who knows thing very well {*T*}, or someone with vast and comprehensive knowledge.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:187	they ask you about the <i>sa-a</i> (the moment i.e. <i>qiyamat</i>) as if you are researching this subject beside everything else	يَسْتَلُونَكَ كَأَنَّكَ حَفِيٌّ عَنْهَا
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Surah *Maryam* says about God:

19:47	He is very kind to me. He looks after my needs	إِنَّهُ كَانَ بِي حَفِيًّا
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"حَفَى بِهِ" (*hafia behi*) means to exaggerate in someone's respect. *Samai* says "حَفَى بِهِ" (*hafia behi*) means to be when needed, and to make him stay with respect {*T*}.

47:37	If he asks you (for wealth) and insists on his demand: pursues you or sticks to you or keeps after you bare footed.	إِنْ يَسْتَلْكُمْ هَا فَيَحْضِكُمْ
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Ibn Faris has said that the root basically means to prevent, to be excessive in asking, and to be bare-foot.

This root also contains the connotation of uprooting something.

“إِحْفَاءُ الشَّوَارِبِ” (*ihfa-ush shawarib*): to shave off the moustache from the roots.

Muheet has quoted a verse by **Abu Faras** in **Hamdan Advi**:

أَغَايَةُ الدِّينِ أَنْتَحِفُوا شَوَارِبَكُمْ - يَا أُمَّةً ضَحِكْتَ مِنْ جَهْلِهَا الْأُمَمُ

Which means: “*Has the importance of Deen (this way of life) been reduced to shaving off your mustache only? The nations of the world are laughing at your idiocy.*”

H-Q-B

ح ق ب

“الْحَقَبُ” (*al-haqab*): the strap that passes under the camel’s belly and is fastened to the ‘howdah’.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meanings of the word are to prevent or imprison.

“الْحَقِيبَةُ” (*al-haqeebah*) means sack, especially the sack which dangles at the back side of the camel’s seat.

“الْمُحَقَّبُ” (*al-mohqib*): a man who allows someone else to ride at his back on the camel.

“إِحْتَقَبَ فُلَانٌ” (*ihteqab fulan*): that man tied something to the camel’s seat and let it dangle.

“إِحْتَقَبَ فُلَانٌ الْإِثْمَ” (*ihteqaba fulanul ism*): that man tied a bundle of sins behind him.

“الْحَقْبَةُ مِنَ الدَّاهِرِ” (*al-hiqba minad dahar*): a period of time which cannot be measured.

“الْحُقْبُ” (*al-huqbu*), “الْحُقْبُ” (*al-huqub*): time, a period of 80 years, a year and many years. The plural is

“أَحْقَابُ” (*ahqaab*). This word denotes an unlimited period of time {R}.

Lataif-ul-Lugha has written that it means “الْدَّهْرُ” (*ad-dahr*), which is indefinite time.

Surah **Al-Kahaf** says:

18:60	Keep walking (moving on) for years and years.	أَوْ أَمْضَىٰ حَقْبًا
78:23	they will live in it (jahannum) for an indefinite time	لَيَبِثَنَّ فِيهَا أَحْقَابًا
11:107	As long as the sky and the earth exist.	مَادَامَتِ السَّمَوَاتُ وَ الْأَرْضُ

H-Q-F

ح ق ف

“الْحِقْفُ” (*al-hiqfu*): means long, high or big, round sand dune. Plural is “أَحْقَافُ” (*ahqaaf*). Also means a winding, sandy land.

“أَحْقَافُ” (*ahqaaf*) is used in 46:21 for the dunes and mountains between **Oman** and **Hazarmot** in Yemen where the nation of **Aad** used to live {L}.

H-Q-Q

ح ق ق

“حَقٌّ” (*haqq*) means for something to be present, happen or to be proven in way which cannot be denied {L}. It means for something to present itself in concrete form, or to be established.

Words in which “ح” (*ha*) and “ق” (*qaf*) appear together give a positive meaning.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings include health (good health), stability and establishment.

“عِنْدَ حَقٍّ لِفَاحِهَا” (*inda haq liqaa-heha*): after a she camel’s pregnancy was established.

“رَجُلٌ حَاقٌّ الرَّجُلِ” (*rajulun ha-aqqar rajul*): means that man’s manliness is an undeniable truth

”رَمَى فَاحَقَّ الرَّمِيَّةَ“ (*rama fa-ahaqqar ramiyyah*): he shot the arrow and the animal died, Thus, it was proven that his arrow had hit the target. The dead animal Hence, proved that the arrow had found its mark.
 ”اِخْتَقَّتْ بِمِ الطَّعْنَةِ“ (*ihdaqat behit ta'nah*): spear injured him, and proved that the attack was indeed fruitful.
 ”طَعْنَهُ مُحَقَّقَةً“ (*ta'na mohaqaqa*), or ”مُحَقَّقَةً“ (*mohtaqqqa*): it is said when the spear goes through and leaves no doubt that it had hit its target.
 ”حَقٌّ“ (*haqq*) Thus, means for something to be established as a solid event or reality.

Surah *Al-Ahqaf* says that the criminals will be made to stand before their punishment and asked:

46:34	Say if the law of consequences is a reality or not?	أَلَيْسَ هَذَا بِالْحَقِّ
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Similarly when *Yusuf* gained prominence in Egypt, he said to his father:

12:100	this is the reality behind the dream which I had in my childhood, my Sustainer has presented it in the form of a solid event	هَذَا تَأْوِيلُ رُؤْيَايَ مِنْ قَبْلُ قَدْ جَعَلَهَا رَبِّي حَقًّا
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Similarly surah *Hijr* says that when *Ibrahim's* guests gave him the good news about a son in old age, Ibrahim was surprised, and they said:

15:55	the good news we are giving you will come before you as a solid reality	بَشْرَتِكَ بِالْحَقِّ
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Thus, ”حَقٌّ“ (*haqq*) means for something to appear as a solid event or reality.

A solid reality can incorporate changes only if its development is constructive, Therefore, *haqq* means the positive and constructive results of deeds.

”تَحْقِيقٌ“ (*tehqeeq*) means to weave cloth very strongly {L}.

”تَوْبٌ مُحَقَّقٌ“ (*saubun muhaqaqa*) is a cloth which has a strong weave {M}.

”الْحَقُّ“ (*al-hiqq*) are the camels which have completed three years (of age) and entered the fourth, and are now able to bear a load, and they are now also capable of making female camels pregnant and Thus, are productive {T}.

”إِحْتَقَّ الْفَرَسُ“ (*ehdaqal faras*) means that the horse became weak, or emaciated.

”إِحْتَقَّ الْمَالُ“ (*ihdaqal maal*) means that the cattle fattened.

”إِنْحَقَّتِ الْعُقْدَةُ“ (*inhaqqatil uqdah*): the knot was very tight {T}. Hence, *haqq* means solid, constructive event, which is established and solid, which cannot be erased.

The Quran uses ”يُحِقُّ“ (*yuhiqqo*) as against ”يَمْحُو“ (*yamho*):

42:24	Allah's laws of the universe, destroy the results of destructive forces, and maintains the results of the constructive forces, which keep their presence in solid shape:	وَيَمْحُو اللَّهُ الْبَاطِلَ وَيُحِقُّ الْحَقَّ بِكَلِمَاتِهِ
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Anything can last only if it is according to the laws of protection and permanence, also which can meet the needs of times which is right in its own place and also meets the need of the changing times.

Therefore, another meaning of *haqq* is intellect and knowledge, fair play and justice, and to be right in accordance with the times.

Raghib has explained this through an example. Nowadays there are locks on doors but in older times there used to be a projected wooden bar which used to fit the socket in such manner that it used to stay in place as well as swing with the door. *Raghib* says that *haqq* is like that. Therefore, *haqq* also means an inventor who invents keeping the needs of sagacity in mind.

”الْحَقُّ مِنَ الْفَرَسِ“ (*alhaqqo minal faras*): means a horse which steps with its hind legs right where it foreleg fell {T}.

In the light of the above meanings, the right connotation of ”حَقٌّ“ (*haqq*) and ”بَاطِلٌ“ (*baatil*) may be comprehended.

“حَقَّ الْأَمْرُ بِحَقِّ” (*haqqul amro yahaqqo*) and “يَحِقُّ” (*yahiqqo*) mean that that act became compulsory. “حَقِيقَةً” (*haqiqah*) is something whose protection is compulsory for you. “حَقًّا عَلَى الْمُتَّقِينَ” (*haqqa alal muttaqeen*) as used in 2:180 means this very thing, that the *muttaqeen* are under compulsion not only to follow those laws, but also to protect them.

The flag of a country is also called “حَقِيقَةً” (*haqiqah*) because it establishes the presence of a country and its protection is compulsory on its citizens.

“حَقَّ الطَّرِيقُ” (*haqqal tareeq*) means that he mounted and walked in the middle of the road, and Thus, his presence became prominent {T}.

Surah *Yunus* has used the word *haqq* as against “ظَنُّ” (*zann*) in 10:36 where it has been said that *zann* does not work against *haqq* at all. Therefore, *haqq* should be followed and not *zann*. *Deen* is totally *haqq* and there is no place for *zann* in it, as said in 10:30. God is *haqq* Himself, and his messenger is *haqq* as well.

The Quran which He has sent is *haqq* (34:6). Its promises (laws) are also *haqq* (10:55). Its way of live is *haqq* (9:33), and this universe has been created with *haqq* (39:5).

Since *haqq* is higher than *zann* or doubts, and it is present in a solid constructive event, Therefore, the appearance of results is also called “الْحَاقَّةُ” (*al-haqqah*), as in 69:1.

The above explanations show that *haqq* is not something mental, intellectual, or conceptual. This is the name for the concept and beliefs in life that make their appearance in solid shape, which are compatible with the times and which are not dependent on external reasoning for their truth, but are like the sun, which are proof of their own. No belief about this world can be proven *haqq* until its constructive results appear in the form of reality.

The Quran says that the sky will be torn asunder and the earth will become empty. For details see Mafoomul Quran.

After this it is said:

84:2-5	It will act upon the laws made by its Sustainer and it has been so (to act so) created.	وَأَذِنَتْ لِرَبِّهَا وَحُقَّتْ
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Similarly for making the results of deeds becoming compulsory, it has been said:

7:30	(a group) was committed to go astray	حَقُّ عَلَيْهِمُ الضَّلَالَةُ
17:16	So was proven against it their word	فَحَقَّقْنَا لَهَا الْقَوْلَ
50:14	So was proven my promise	فَحَقَّقُوا وَعْدِي
38:14	So was proven my penalty	فَحَقَّقُوا عِقَابِي
10:103	to protect the <i>momineen</i> from the conspiracies of the opponents is incumbent upon us	حَقًّا عَلَيْنَا نُنَاجِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ

“حَقِيقٌ” (*haqqeq*): proper, essential, compulsory, or must (7:105).

“اِسْتَحَقَّ اِثْمًا” (*istahaqqa innama*): that they committed a crime. Here too, this word has been used for the act to be committed, for it to become an event (5:107).

These are the basic meanings of *haqq*. See heading (*B-Te-L*) for “بَاطِلٌ” (*baatil*) as against *haqq* so that the meaning of *haqq* becomes more clear.

“أَلْحَكَمَةُ” (*al-hakamah*) means the horse’s rein {T}, rather the bit which is then tied to the leather so that it tightens both the jaws, so that they do not move. It is called “حَكْمَةٌ” (*hakamah*).

“أَحْكَمُ الْفَرَسِ” (*ahkamal faras*) means to rein a horse like this, since this rein is to keep the horse in check.

Hence, it is said:

“حَكَمْتُ الْفَرَسَ” (*hakamtul faras*): I stopped the horse and (with the help of the reign) controlled him.

“أَحْكَمَهُ عَنِ الْأَمْرِ” (*ahkamahu unil amr*): he prevented him from it, stopped him.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is to stop or prevent, to tell a person, which are his limits that he cannot exceed. This is, making a decision in controversial matters. That is to ascertain the limits of one’s rights and responsibilities, and not allow them to exceed them. This is the meaning of “حُكْمٌ” (*hookum*), which is order, or decision {T}.

“حَاكِمٌ” (*haakim*) means one who decides, one who orders something as foregoing.

“حَكَمَ بَيْنَهُمْ كَذَلِكَ” (*hakama bainahum kazalik*) means he decided Thus, between them {T}.

“أَلْحُكُومَةُ” (*al-hukumah*) is the noun.

“أَلْحَكَمُ” (*al-hakamo*): arbitrator with authority or reach, one who can decide finally for or against, one who imposes the law (6:115, 4:35).

“أَلْحِكْمَةُ” (*al-hikmah*) means to keep fair play and justice in mind while deciding. That is, to fix everyone’s limits and not allow them to transgress. This is why a “حَكِيمٌ” (*hakeem*) is a person who deals with matters in a balanced way, keeping all aspects in mind {T}.

“حَكَمَ” (*hakam*): stop something at one spot, anything which stops firmly at one place.

“أَحْكَمَهُ” (*ahkamah*): made it stolid, made it immovable from that spot {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says that “حِكْمَةٌ” (*hikmah*) is called so, because it prevents from unawareness.

In *Allama Iqbal*’s view (a very famous poet of the East); “حِكْمَةٌ” (*hikmah*) is an opinion with authority, that is, the power to decide and the power to implement the decision. This is nowadays called ‘governance’.

The Quran has been described as “حَكِيمٌ” (*hakeem*) in 36:2, because it fixes the right point for everything and does not let it transgress. It decides all controversial affairs. God too has been called “حَكِيمٌ” (*hakeem*) in 2:32 because He operates the universe on sound grounds and creates everything in the right proportion and controls everything with his laws.

2:113	He decides affairs controversial among men	يَحْكُمُ بَيْنَهُمْ فِيمَا كَانُوا فِيهِ يَخْتَلِفُونَ
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The Quran has said that its verses are of two kinds, “مُحْكَمَاتٌ” (*mohkamaat*) and “مُتَشَابِهَاتٌ” (*mutashabhaat*). This is a very important point and must be well understood.

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says the following in ordinary language:

3:7	Allah is the One who has revealed this Book to you. One kind of verses it contains is ‘ <i>mohkam</i> ’, and these are the basis of the Book. The other kind is ‘ <i>mutashabihaat</i> ’ (figurative). Therefore, those who have some mischief in their hearts, latch on to the ‘ <i>mutashabihaats</i> ’ to make them controversial by attributing different meanings to them, although their true meaning is known only to Allah and those who are solid in knowledge. Those say that we have trust in all of them (the verses) and these are all from our Sustainer. The truth is that truth can be understood only by those who have insight and intellect.	هُوَ الَّذِي أَنْزَلَ عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ مِنْهُ آيَاتٌ مُحْكَمَاتٌ هُنَّ أُمُّ الْكِتَابِ وَأُخَرُ مُتَشَابِهَاتٌ - فَأَمَّا الَّذِينَ فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ زَيْغٌ فَيَتَّبِعُونَ مَا تَشَابَهَ مِنْهُ ابْتِغَاءَ الْفِتْنَةِ وَابْتِغَاءَ تَأْوِيلِهِ وَمَا يَعْلَمُ تَأْوِيلَهُ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَالرَّاسِخُونَ فِي الْعِلْمِ يَقُولُونَ آمَنَّا بِهِ كُلٌّ مِنْ عِنْدِ رَبِّنَا وَمَا يَذَّكَّرُ إِلَّا أُولُو الْأَلْبَابِ
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As seen above, **mohkam** means resolute, unmoving in its place, one who decides clearly and solidly, but here it has been used as against **mutashabeaat**. Thus, **mohkam** would mean that which is not **mutashaabea** or similar. **Mutashabeaa** would mean that which is not **mohkam**. This means that **mohkamaat** and **mutashabeaat** are two types of verses in the Quran.

For detailed meaning of “مُتَشَابِهٌ” (**mutashaabeh**) see under heading (Sh-B-H). Briefly, it means similar or like one another.

Mohkam would Therefore, mean firstly the verses which mean exactly what they say. For instance, in the case of **nikaah** (the marriage contract) it is said:

4:23	your mothers are forbidden for you (you all are forbidden to wed your mothers)	حُرِّمَتْ عَلَيْكُمْ أُمَّهَاتُكُمْ
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Here “أُمٌّ” (**umm**) means mother, that is, the woman who gives birth to a child, but as mentioned earlier under verse 3:7, “بُنَىٰ أُمِّ الْكِتَابِ” (**hunna ummul kitaab**) is not that kind of mother. The word **umm** has been used metaphorically and it means the basis and real. This is the explanation of the word.

“تَأْوِيلٌ” (**ta’weel**) means end result, the ultimate reality of anything. The Quran contains the guiding principles for Mankind. Obviously, the words and meaning of such principles and rules should be such whose meanings are evident from the very words, as in “حُرِّمَتْ عَلَيْكُمْ أُمَّهَاتُكُمْ” (**hurremat alaikum umma-haatekum**) (4:23). These verses are ‘**mohkamaats**’. But at the same time, the Quran also contains such truths which are beyond our comprehension, as Allah’s personality and His traits, life after death and the results of our deeds, the concepts of **jannah** and **jahannam** or the end purpose of human life. It is obvious that such truths can only be told allegorically.

This means that they will be related symbolically. For instance, it has been said about Allah:

7:54	He sat on the arsh (came to stay on the throne)	ثُمَّ اسْتَوَىٰ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ
11:7	His arsh (throne) is on water	كَانَ عَرْشُهُ عَلَى الْمَاءِ

Obviously in these verses “عَرْشٌ” (**arsh**) is not a throne made of wood or some other material, and “مَاءٌ” (**ma’a**) also does not mean water. This is an allegory, that is, these facts have been related in an allegorical or symbolic way. Thus, these verses are **mutashabeaat**. Meaning that these verses are such in which truths have been related in an allegorical way.

It is also true that the truths which are beyond our senses cannot be comprehended by us. Although by deliberating on similar things which have been related, we can get some, not total, idea as to what they may be. As from the word we can understand, that it means authority or control, or in 11:7 “مَاءٌ” (**ma’a**) means the fountainhead of life, because at another place in the Quran, it is said:

21:30	we made every living thing from water:	وَجَعَلْنَا مِنَ الْمَاءِ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ حَيٍّ
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But we cannot understand how He exercises His control or how He created the life form. We have been given a very small part of these truths:

17:85	And of knowledge ye have been vouchsafed but little.	وَمَا أُوتِيتُمْ مِنَ الْعِلْمِ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا
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However, we can exercise our intellect, knowledge and insight to reach the level of guidance meant for us by these indications:

3:7	And not will they take heed, except men of understanding.	وَمَا يَذَّكَّرُ أَزْوَاجُ الْأَنْبَابِ
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Two types of mentalities have been mentioned about such verses, i.e. **mutashabeaat**. One belongs to those who are out to create controversies, that is, by leading mankind away from the basic truths about life and into mere rhetoric and into spending their energy in futile pursuits. In order to understand these beyond-comprehension truths, they keep on projecting different concepts and thoughts, and consider all this to be the height of knowledge. They consider human matters as lowly and are always engaged in celestial matters. This Quran says is the wrong path, and makes one oblivious of practical life.

On the contrary, people with the other type of mentality are those whom the Quran calls “رَاسِخُونَ فِي الْعِلْمِ” (*raasekhoona fil ilm*) and “أُولَى الْأَلْبَابِ” (*oolil albaab*), which is those who exercise their intellect and thought, and go on becoming more mature in their knowledge. They, it has been said, build their thoughts on the structure of trust. This means that they say that all these truths have been related by God who has the knowledge about all things. As such, there can be no doubt about their being the truths.

Therefore, there is no doubt that they are the truth but we cannot grasp their real connotation. However, the human guidance that they can provide us, we can certainly reach through the use of our intellect and understanding, but this is the limit of our understanding of these truths. Only Allah is aware of the real connotation of these truths and people can only understand them as far as human guidance is concerned.

The Quran has said at several places that man can derive the right results from knowledge if he uses his intellect under the guidance of the celestial revelation. For example see 46:26 or 25:23. It must also be understood that there are two types of believers. One type will be of those people who believe in the celestial message as it is, and the other is of those people of knowledge and perception who use their intellect to deliberate on the truths of the celestial message.

Surah *Al-Mudassar* has called the latter group “الَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْكِتَابَ” (*al-lazeena ootul kitab*), which are those with more understanding of the book, whereas common folk have been called “الْمُؤْمِنُونَ” (*al-muminoon*), or just the believers (72:31).

Surah *Al-Mudassar* talks in detail about the two groups mentioned above and their mentality.

Also it has been said about “سَقَرٌ” (*sagar*) or hellish state that:

74:31	nineteen angels are posted there	عَلَيْهَا تِسْعَةَ عَشَرَ
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Obviously, this is only a parable and after that it has been said:

74:31	And not we have made their number, unless a trial for those who deny	وَمَا جَعَلْنَا عِدَّتَهُمُ الْآفَتَةَ لِلَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا
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Their count i.e. the count of 19 is a cause for chaos for those who deny the truths of the Quran. But conversely:

74:31	those who have been given the knowledge of the Book strengthen their belief through this Book and the common believers increase their faith through it	وَلَا يَرْتَابَ الَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْكِتَابَ وَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ
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However, whether it is the elite of the believers or the commoners they never find the allegorical tales of the Quran as doubtful, but:

74:31	Those whose hearts are diseased and also those who do not believe in the Quran ask as to what does Allah really mean when He presents these allegories?	لِيَكُونُوا لِلَّذِينَ فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ مَرَضٌ وَ الْكَافِرُونَ مَاذَا أَرَادَ اللَّهُ بِهَذَا
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After that it is said that the truths in the Quran have been related through parables. Whoever wants to derive guidance from these can do so and whoever wants to be misled can also do so. After that it has been said:

74:31	these are the soldiers of Allah about whose reality and connotation only He can tell	وَمَا يَعْلَمُ جُنُودَ رَبِّكَ إِلَّا هُوَ
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And then it is also said:

74:31	but their allegorical mention is there for the guidance of human beings	وَمَا هِيَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ لِلْبَشَرِ
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As such those who are convinced that they are the truth do not try to find their exact connotation etc. but through the use of intellect and deliberation, reach the guidance that is meant for them. This is the first

meaning of the verses that are called “مُحْكَمَاتٌ” (*muh-kamaah*) and “مُتَشَابِهَاتٌ” (*muta- shabihaat*).

Muta-shabihaat also include truths that have been related in words that are similar to others but the meaning of which every person can derive as per his own knowledge level and intellect or the persons of different eras can glean according to the advancement of that time. The Quran is guidance for every level of human being and person in every era. We find that even during the same era people possess intellect and knowledge that is different from others of the same era, and if the Quran had related its truths which only a particular set of people could understand, then it could not have been meant for eternity as at present nor be universal and could have been suited to only people of a certain era or people of a certain level only. Then it would have been useless for all others. It was Therefore, necessary to describe the truths in a way that could be interpreted in many different ways so that people with all mental levels during all eras could benefit from it.

Actually the choice of words is also a characteristic of the Quran. These words not only represent the truth at all times but men of all mental levels can benefit from it. For instance the Quran says about the celestial system:

36:40	Everything is progressing in its own circle.	كُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ
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And about the sun the Quran says:

36:38	the sun is travelling towards its destiny	وَالشَّمْسُ تَجْرِي لِمُسْتَقَرٍّ هَآ
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Obviously till the ancient beliefs about the universe were prevalent there could be no right concept about the planets and the stars. When later the astronomer *Copernicus* came out with his theory about the universe and the celestial bodies, then it was known as to how the celestial bodies revolve in their respective circles. Similarly, until *Herschel's* theory came to light, nobody could imagine that the sun along with all bodies within its system was travelling towards its destiny. Until human knowledge had not reached this far, the Quranic verses regarding these were *mutashabihaat* or metaphors, but after the discoveries and revelations, the related verses entered the realm of *muhkumaat*.

Now these verses hold the status of *muhkumaat* for persons of a certain mental level. For people below that level they still hold the status of *mutashabihaat*. Till these verses were included among the *mutashabihaat*, and the discoveries were not made only Allah knew about the truth in them. When these discoveries were made then these verses entered the realm of *muhkumaat*, and their reality was disclosed to some people of thought and knowledge. It is due to such instances that it has been said that Allah has revealed the Quran, and Who is aware of the highs and lows in the universe (25:6).

After a few verses, it is said that if you want to know anything about these matters then:

25:59	ask the One who is aware	فَسْئَلْ بِهِ خَيْرًا
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Until human knowledge reaches a certain stage, only Allah is aware of those truths. He is the one who has related the truths in parables through the celestial revelation. When human knowledge reaches that level, then human beings too, those who are in a position to know, will become aware of those truths as well. As such, this is also one meaning of *mutashabihaat* and *muhkumaat*.

These are the various meaning of *mutashabihaat* and *muhkumaat* of the Quranic verses. But whether it is *mutashabihaat* or *muhkumaat*, all verses are strong and authoritative in their own right. Every single word of the Quran is like a rock, established in its place.

That is why Surah *Hood* says:

11:1	This is a book of which all verses are authoritative for this book, comprises of permanent values.	كِتَابٌ أُحْكِمَتْ آيَاتُهُ
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The truths it contains are unchangeable and its principles too do not know change. The truths that have been related in parables are also unchangeable in their veracity. From this point of view, all verses of the

Quran are *muhkumaat*.

On the contrary, Surah *Al-Zumr* says that the whole book is comprised of '*muta-shabihaat*':

39:23	Allah has presented the most balanced narrations in this <i>kitaab</i> that are <i>mutashibihaat</i> rather than <i>masani</i>	اللَّهُ نَزَّلَ أَحْسَنَ الْحَدِيثِ كِتَابًا مُتَشَابِهًا مَثَانِي
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But here the word *mutashabihan* has not been used opposite the word of *muhkimun*, but it has been used opposite the word "مَثَانِي" (*masani*). For the meaning of "مَثَانِي" (*masani*), see heading (Th-N-Y).

But briefly, it is mentioned here that '*masani*' is used for two things that are opposite one another. It is the style of the Quran that it brings two opposites to face each other to make the meaning clear. For example "نور" (*noor*) or light is explained by bringing its opposite "ظلم" (*darkness*) in front of it. These two, light and darkness are each other's '*masani*', or opposite of each other. By explaining things this way, it can make everything very clear. As such some philosophers think that things are known by their opposites. But this may lead one to think that the Quran mentions only opposites to which Allah said "No!" There is no contradiction in the Quran (4:83). All its verses are similar '*mutashabiha*' to each other. The opposites are mentioned only to make things clear. Therefore, the verses of the Quran are similar or '*mutashabiha*' besides being opposite.

In this way, the Quran is a book that is *kitabun muta-shabihan masani*. Alternatively, it can be said that similar or *muta-shabihan* is the style in which truths have been mentioned, such as '*noorun wa hadyun*' that is light and guidance, and opposites or '*masani*' is the style where a thing has been explained by bringing an opposite before it. "سَبْعًا مِنَ الْمَثَانِي" (*sab-un minas saani*) as in 15:28. See heading (Th-N-Y).

The Quran has used the word "حِكْمَةٌ" (*hikmah*) along with the word "كِتَابٌ" (*kitabun*) which means a book of wisdom.

2:151	And teaches you about the book (law) and the <i>hikmah</i>	وَيُعَلِّمُكُمُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْحِكْمَةَ
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Law is one thing and there is another which is the reason or (why of it). The law has been called "كِتَابٌ" (*kitab*). See heading (*K-T-B*), and its why, or reason it is called the "حِكْمَةٌ" (*hikmah*). Because it is '*hikmah*' that tells us why that particular law has been made. If the Quran wanted to impose that law by force, then only the book of law or '*kitab*' would have been enough, but since the Quran wants believers to act on the laws with equanimity and fully voluntarily, it is necessary to impart the reasoning of the law along with the law. These are both given by Allah through the divine revelation, and are safe in the Quran.

Surah *An-Nisaa* says:

4:113	Allah has revealed the book and its reasoning towards you	وَأَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ وَالْحِكْمَةَ
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Also see 17:39.

At some place the Quran has been called "الْحِكْمَةُ" (*al-hikmah*) only as in 17:39. At others places it has been called both the *kitab* and *al-hikmah*, and only one pronoun has been used for both, as in 2:231. So that it can be made clear that these two are one and the same thing.

Surah *Azhaab* has made it clear by saying that '*al-hikmah*' is also to be followed. All these things make it evident that reasoning or '*hikmah*' is within the Quran, not outside of it.

Revealing the '*hikmah*' through divine revelation also had a special purpose. The Quran has given us laws and rules in order to achieve results. That is, its laws and rules are not there just for the sake of it, but have been given in order to produce definite results. If only laws were received from Allah and it was not revealed as to what results can be achieved through them, then maybe we would have acted upon those laws as we deemed fit, and would be content that we had done Allah's will. However, this was not the case. He gave us laws and also told us what results they would produce if followed faithfully. As such, we will always have to ensure that those laws are indeed producing the results that Allah has ordained. If yes,

then the laws are being followed correctly. But if not, then we will have to review and find out where we are going wrong and why the desired results as ordained by Allah are not being produced.

For instance, the Quran says:

29:45	Establish <i>as-salah</i> , indeed, <i>as-salah</i> prevents <i>fahsha</i> and evil deeds.	أَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ إِنَّ الصَّلَاةَ تَنْهَى عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَالْمُنْكَرِ
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Here “أَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ” (*aaqimis salat*) or the establishing of “صَلَاةَ” (*salat*) is an order (*kitab*), and the second part that “صَلَاةَ” (*salat*) will prevent forbidden things i.e. “فَحْشَاءَ” (*fah-sha*) and negate all that is undesirable its reasoning. If *salat* is not producing this result, then we should find out where we are going wrong, because when Allah Himself says that *salat* will produce such and such result, then if *salat* is being established in the right way, it should produce that result.

Because the result has also been created by Allah, it can never be wrong. In *Deen*, or the Quranic way of life, or system, every command of Allah which is followed correctly, produces its result as ordained by Allah. This was the meaning of *kitab* and *hikmah*. Also see heading (*K-T-B*).

Hukman also means that strength of decision making power, or understanding that is available to a common person even without the knowledge of revelation.

Surah *Al-Qasas* says about *Moosa*:

28:14	When he reached maturity and his limbs became balanced, then We endowed him with <i>hokum</i> (understanding or decision power and knowledge).	وَلَمَّا بَلَغَ أَشُدَّهُ وَاسْتَوَى آتَيْنَاهُ حُكْمًا وَعِلْمًا
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The context reveals that this is before *Moosa* was given prophet hood, and Therefore, does not mean that this *hikmat* was the same as the one made available through divine revelation. This is the reasoning or *hikmat* that enables one to apply Allah’s order and principle to details or to mundane things as it is suitable to the era and situation in general. Or, the application of which command or principle will be most appropriate. But all this deliberation and reasoning is quite different from that *hikmah* which is acquired through the ‘*wahi*’ and which is found in the Quran.

About the Messenger (*pbuh*), the Quran says:

62:2	Reciting to them its verses, and purifying them, and teaching them the book and the wisdom.	يَتْلُو عَلَيْهِمْ آيَاتِهِ وَيُزَكِّيهِمْ وَيُعَلِّمُهُمُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْحِكْمَةَ
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All four aspects as ‘*tilawa*’ (following the verses), ‘*aaya*’ (signs of Allah), ‘*tazkiyah*’ (cleansing of the body and soul with education) and ‘*kitab*’ (laws), are present here.

It means that you, (messenger *Muhammed*) impart the teaching of the ‘*kitab*’ or the book and the reasoning behind the verses that are found within the Quran, and towards the formation of that system practically, and in this way decide the correct application and implementation of Allah’s system. Through this education and training he desires to teach the followers that they too should employ this strategy in their lives. The reasoning related by the Quran is unchangeable as are its laws, but this reasoning or ‘*hikmah*’ will continue to change, as it is applied to changing circumstances.

Governance: the Quran says in principle that no human being has the right to govern another, even if he may enjoy full authority to do so (3:78). The right to adjudicate between people and to make decisions accepted belongs only to Allah (12:40). This governance of Allah is established through His book (6:115). But the need to implement practically the decisions of the Quran a living and present authority is inevitable. This is called the Islamic system or Islamic republic which was first established by our Messenger *Muhammed* (pbuh). The central authority of this system was the obedience of Allah because the authority made everyone obey the laws and commands of Allah and not the decisions of anyone else (4:65, 5:48).

After *Muhammed*, this system was carried forward by the *Khalifas* (caliphs) of Islam and was called the path of the prophet (3:143). The ‘*deen*’ or the way of Islam can only be found in an Islamic republic. It is

not an individual matter. ‘Allah’s governance’ means this very thing, i.e. to govern as per the dictates of the Quran. Those who do not do this are called **kafirs**, or the deniers by the Quran (5:44).

Contrary to what many say today, an Islamic government can certainly be established at any time as demonstrated by our beloved prophet **Muhammed** (pbuh).

H-L-F

ح ل ف

“الْحَلْفُ” (*al-halfu*), “الْحَلِيفُ” (*al-halif*) means a promise that is made between two individuals in order to seal a deal. Later it began to mean any ordinary promise {*M*}.

“الْحِلْفُ” (*al-hilf*) is a promise made between people. It also means friendship and friend.

“الْحَلِيفُ” (*al-haleef*): someone with whom a pact has been made.

“حَلَّافٌ” (*halaaf*) means one who makes too many promises {*T*} 68:10.

“حَلَفَ” (*halafa*), “يَحْلِفُ” (*yahlifa*) means to promise {*T*} 4:62.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to stick with another. This led to its meaning to abide by.

H-L-Q

ح ل ق

“حَلَقَةٌ” (*halqah*) means any circle whether it is of human beings or of gold, silver or iron.

“الْحَلَقَةُ” (*al-halqa*) means armor, weapon, and rope, round mark atop a camel {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning includes cleaning of hair, or to shave the head.

This led to “حَلَقَ يَحْلِقُ” (*halaqa yahliqu*) which means to shave the head {*T*}.

Raghib also says that “حَلَقٌ” (*halq*) actually means to cut off hair.

“الْحَلْقُ” (*al-halq*) means the place where animals are slaughtered {*T*}. The inner part of it is called “حُلُقُومٌ” (*hulqum*), “حَلَقٌ” (*halaqa*), “يَحْلِقُ” (*yahliqu*).

The Quran says:

48:27	those who shave off their heads	مُحَلِّقِينَ رُءُوسَكُمْ
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“حُلُقُومٌ” (*hulqum*) also means the throat as in 56:83.

Maulana Abeerullah Sindhi writes that among the descendants of **Ibrahim**, the hair on the forehead was thought to be sacred just like the **khes** (head hair) among **Sikhs** and the **bodi** or tail among Hindus. The Arabs at that time also used to maintain hair with great sanctity and used to have them cut at the point of **Mina** during **Hajj** and this shave was thought to be equal to sacrificing the head {**Maulana Sindhi's tafseer** or explanation named **Al-maqamul Mehmood**}.

H-L-L

ح ل ل

The real meaning of “حَلٌّ” (*hall*) is to open a knot.

20:27	Open the knots in my tongue.	وَاحْلُلْ عُقْدَةً مِنْ لِسَانِي
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“حَلٌّ” (*hall*) also means to melt something which has been frozen, that is, its knot was opened and it was solved. Later “حَلَّ الْمَكَانَ” (*hal lul makan*) came to mean to arrive at some place and stay.

Raghib says that “حَلَّ الْأَحْمَالِ” (*halla-al-ahmal*) means to open the knots of ropes tying the luggage in order to dismount them from camels.

“حَالَةً” (*hallah*) means to dismount or stay along with someone.

“حَالِيلٌ” (*haleel*) has been derived from this root, which means husband and “حَالِيلَةٌ” (*haleelah*) means wife.

Because these two live people in the same house with each other, or they are “حَالِلٌ” (*halal*) or permissible for each other.

The Quran says “حَالَءُ أَبْنَاءِكُمْ” (*hala-eelu abna'ikum*) in 4:23. “حَالَائِلٌ” (*halail*) is the plural of “حَالِيلَةٌ” (*haleelah*) i.e. the wives of your sons.

“الْحَالَّةُ” (*al-halla*): neighborhood, the destination of the nation.

“الْحِلَّةُ” (*al-hilla*): a nation which has come down. It also means neighborhood

“الْحُلَّةُ” (*al-hulla*): a pair of clothes, as shirt, blanket or cloak. It also means wife by implication.

“الْحِلُّ” (*al-hillu*) is the place outside or the sacred place of Muslims.

“التَّحْلِيلُ” (*al-tahilla*): something used to atone for broken promises and in this way their knots are opened.

“حَلَّ أَمْرُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ” (*halla amarullah alaih*) means that the matter of Allah was made incumbent upon him.

Ubab says that “يَحِلُّ” (*yahillu*) means to be incumbent and “يُحْلِلُ” (*ya-hullu*) means to be revealed or to come down {T}.

“الْحَالِلُ” (*al-halal*) is the opposite of “حَرَامٌ” (*haram*) or impermissible or that which does not have the knot of impermissibility on it. That is things which are allowed to be eaten and which have not been declared impermissible.

“الْحِلُّ وَالْحَالِيلُ” (*al-hillu wal haleel*) also means this {T, M}.

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:2	Do not open the knots that have been tied in respect and reverence. (Respect them).	لَا تُحِلُّوا شَعَائِرَ اللَّهِ
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Regarding becoming incumbent it is said:

20:81	My wrath shall become incumbent upon you	فَيَحِلُّ عَلَيْكُمْ غَضَبِي
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About the place of animals sacrificed during *Al-Hajj* it is said:

22:23	the place of their slaughter is the Kaaba	ثُمَّ مَحَلُّهَا إِلَى الْبَيْتِ الْمُقَدَّسِ
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Surah *Al-Badar* says:

90:2	you are resident in this city	وَأَنْتَ حِلٌّ بِهَذَا الْبَلَدِ
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Here “حِلٌّ” (*hillun*) may be taken as “حَالِلٌ” (*halal*) or permissible {R}, and it may also mean that they did not respect even this city of peace and persecuted you by being inimical to your life.

Maulana Mehmoodul Hasan writes that this phrase means ‘and there will be no bar on you in this city’.

As far as *halaal* and *haraam* i.e. permissible and impermissible are concerned in Islam, the Quran teaches that everything that the Quran has declared as *haraam* (see heading (H-R-M), all other edibles are *halaal* or permissible. That there is no bar on their consumption, nor has anyone been given the right to declare anything as forbidden or impermissible or *haram*. See 5:78, 6:146, 6:119-120, 10:59, 16:116, and 22:30.

Even the messenger *Muhammed* has not been given this right to declare anything *haraam* (66:1).

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says about *Muhammed*:

7:157	he will declare the pure things as <i>halaal</i> or permissible and the impure things as <i>haraam</i> or impermissible	يُحِلُّ لَهُمُ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَيُحَرِّمُ عَلَيْهِمُ الْخَبَائِثَ
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There it means that he (the Messenger) will do it through celestial guidance or *wahi*, through the Quran 6:146, 5:1.

But the Quran has also said “طَيِّبًا” (*tayyiban*) along with *halaal* in 2:168 that is, you can choose from

among the things that you like among the permissible things and need not necessarily take all things that are permissible even if you do not favor them; and do not eat things which are not pleasant for you. The things that are permissible must also be pleasant for you. The edibles should be tasty and good for health as well. They should be delightful in every way. The Quran has made allowances for the taste and likes of every individual and for collective benefit.

Here one point must be understood. According to the Quran, every pure or *tayyab* edible is *halal* or permissible and every impure thing is *haram* or impermissible. This means that everything that Allah has declared as *halal* is by itself pure or *Tayyab*. This does not mean however that all *halal* things should be eaten or consumed even if they do not cater to one's taste. If someone doesn't like something which is *Tayyab*, then he is permitted not to eat it. But it should not be considered *haram* or impermissible. In the same way the Islamic society for greater or collective benefit can declare some things as impermissible for some time, and there is nothing wrong with imposing these prohibitions if necessary but it is not allowed to declare that thing as *haram*. In the same manner nobody is allowed to declare something as *halal* or permissible if it has been declared impure or *haram* by the Quran.

As per Allah's system of sustenance, pure and impure i.e. *halal* and *haram* could also mean that ordinary edibles in nature which Allah has made sustenance for human beings should be allowed to remain available (*halal*), and they should not be withheld and kept away from benefiting people. This is also like making Allah's *halal* as *haram*. This is the basis of the Quranic system which is that free goods should never be turned into economic goods or a commodity for sale. For more details of *halal* and *haram* see heading (H-R-M) and (N-Ain-M). For *Saidul bahar* (catch of the sea) to be *halal*, see heading (B-H-R), and verse no 5:96.

“مُحِلٌّ” (*muhillun*) means he who thinks that a thing which has been declared as *haram*, or forbidden to be *halal* or permissible.

5:1	those who think that the hunted animal or bird is not <i>halal</i> or permitted to be eaten	عَمَّيِرٌ مُحِلِّي الصَّيْدِ
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“حِلٌّ” (*hillun*) means *halal* as in 5:5.

“تَحِلَّةٌ” (*tahilla*) is a kind of atonement, that which frees one from the binding of a promise (66:2).

H-L-M

ح ل م

“الْحُلْمُ” (*al-hulm*), “الْحُلُمُ” (*al-hulum*) means “a dream”. The plural is “أَحْلَامٌ” (*ahlaam*) as used in 12:44. It also means copulation in a dream, and since this condition i.e. copulation is a testimony to one being an adult, it also means adulthood 24:59. And since adulthood also brings understanding “الْحُلْمُ” (*al-hulum*) began to be used to mean peace and tranquility, intelligence and deliberation, and self-control.

52:32	do their understanding and deliberation, their seriousness and sobriety order them or drive them to obey this	أَمْ تَأْمُرُهُمْ أَخْلَامُهُمْ بِهَذَا
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“الْحِلْمُ” (*al-hilm*) means to have self-control so as not to flare up even in anger {R}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is not to hurry, i.e. not to flare up instantly over some trivial thing. Thus, it led to the word “تَحَلَّمَ الْمَالُ” (*tahallamal maal*) which is said when the animals become fat and corpulent, and they become more sturdy too.

“الْحَلِيمُ” (*al-haleem*) is a trait of Allah and is used to mean that neither the disobedience of the unfaithful makes Him flare up nor He is aroused by anger to take some step hastily. Rather, He has framed a law for everything which that thing or being reaches ultimately in any case. This means that every deed has a result, good or bad. Therefore, “حَلِيمٌ” (*haleem*) means understanding, authentic, stable, always one to act according to law and principle, one who does not flare up emotionally.

About **Ibrahim** the Quran says:

11:75	Verily Abraham was sympathetic, being one to revert to Allah	إِنَّ إِبْرَاهِيمَ حَلِيمٌ أَوَّاهٌ مُنِيبٌ
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And about **Ismael** it is said:

37:101	We gave Abraham the good tidings about a haleem (or an understanding son)	فَبَشِّرْهُ بِعَلِيمٍ حَلِيمٍ
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We use “حَلِيمٌ” (*hilm*), or “حليم الطبع” (*hileemut taba-a*) to mean humility, self-effacing, soft spoken but these are the meanings of our own language (Urdu). Simple selflessness is the product of weakness but “حَلِيمٌ” (*hilm*) encompasses a feeling of strength and energy within it, but which is under full control and which does not allow for loss of this control even under very stringent circumstances and does nothing that is cause for repentance. One who cannot face an opponent bows due to weakness and insult, but to have the power to rebel and still bend before law and principle is the height of humility and humanity.

H-L-Y

ح ل ی

“الْحُلِيِّ” (*al-hali*) means jewelry or ornaments, which are made by melting metals or with precious stones {T}. The plural is “حُلِيٌّ” (*hulliun*)

7:128	made a calf out of their ornaments	مَنْ حُلِيَّهِمْ عِجَازًا
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It means that they melted their gold to frame a calf out of it.
“الْحَلِيَّةُ” (*al-hilya*) means a thing or ornament.

16:14	which you recover things of ornaments (such as pearls from the sea)	تَسْتَخْرِجُوا مِنْهُ حَلِيَّةً
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“حَلَا بِاتْحَلِيَّةُ” (*hillahu tahliya*) means he adorned the woman with jewelry {T}.

18:31	they will get to wear things of adornment there	يُحَلَّوْنَ فِيهَا
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Ibn Faris says it basically means luxury.

H-M-A

ح م أ

“الْحَمَاءُ” (*al-hamatu*), “الْحَمَاءُ” (*al-hama*) means black smelly mud, spoiled earth.
“حَمِيَّ الْمَاءِ” (*hamial ma-oo*) means water that has become murky with the amalgamation of black smelly mud. A place which has such water will be covered with a layer of caked “حَمِيَّةٌ” (*hamiyun*). The feminine is “حَمِيَّةٌ” (*haminah*).

About the early stages of man’s creation, the Quran says:

15:26	black transformed earth on which a crust has formed, Allah began man’s creation from it	خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ صَلْصَالٍ مِنْ حَمَاءٍ مَسْنُونٍ
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This very thing has been called “طِينٍ لَازِبٍ” (*teenil lazib*) in 37:11. This means that the earliest living cell was created from the amalgamation of earth and water. Details can be found in my book (**Iblees O Adam**).

The Quran has called the Black Sea as “عَيْنِ حَمِيَّةٍ” (*ainin hamiatin*) in 18:81.

Note: see also last part of heading (H-M-Y).

H-M-D

ح م د

“حَمْدُ” (*hamd*) is the feeling that is created within the human breast at seeing a very rare and very delightful sight or thing. This *hamd* is an appreciation of the Creator of that beautiful thing. This has few conditions which have been related by the author of *Muheet* as follows.

1} the thing that is being acclaimed and lauded must be a palpable and physical thing. That which cannot be felt can never gain our acclamation i.e. which is good in concept only, such as “مقام محمود” (*maqami mahmod*), “صفات محمود” (*sifaat mahmood*) etc. even though they have been mentioned in the Quran.

For example we can only appreciate an artist or painter through his works which come before our eyes in palpable form and we cannot laud his concept only. As such, the Quran has as sarcasm upon those who merely want praise for themselves instead of doing something constructive and then let their works be praised.

3:187	They want to be praised on the basis of the work that they do not produce.	يُحِبُّونَ أَنْ يُحْمَدُوا بِمَا لَمْ يَفْعَلُوا
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2} *the praise for somebody's work must be voluntary, so that the individual ego of he who is praising can also be gauged i.e. whether it is magnanimous enough to praise good work by another. Automatic work or quality which is inherent or incumbent even if it is good does not produce the right occasion for hamd. So much so that the word hamd is not used for beauty and excellence that is present inherently and has necessarily to be acquired. If the qualities are present of their own, then the word “مَدَح” (madah) is used instead of hamd.*

“مَدَحُ الْجَمَالِ” (*madah-al jamal*): if a machine is producing fine things then that machine is not fit for *hamd* but *madah*, but producer of the will be deserving *hamd*. This is also the case with a peacock's dance. The peacock deserves *madah* for the dance and the peacock's Creator deserves *hamd*.

3} For true *hamd* it is also necessary that the thing that is being praised is also actually liked by the one who is praising or is close to his heart; to praise someone because of some pressure is not *hamd* but it is *madah*. *Hamd* does not encompass any sort of deceit, fabrication, pretense or hypocrisy or soft-soaping. In *hamd* the acclaim comes to the surface involuntarily.

4} the thing that is being praised must also be very much correct i.e. it must deserve to be praised. *Hamd* cannot take place only on the basis of some vague concept. *Hamd* can never be done for un-clear concepts, ambiguous outlines, and on the basis of doubt and hesitation. *Hamd* does not arise out of deceit, concept, superstition and blind faith. It is based on solid belief and faith, but *madah* can also be done for opinions, but not *hamd*.

5} the things of benefit, delight and balanced beauty that are being praised or for which *hamd* is being undertaken must have reached perfection and their benefit must be felt and acknowledged. At which is not beneficial to human beings or art which has not reached perfection cannot be praised. For instance the sleight of hand of a pick pocket cannot be praised because it is not beneficial for human beings although it may be perfect.

Hamd is a feeling which meets the conditions given above. If even one of the above conditions is not there then it will be *madah* and not *hamd*. It must be mentioned that the word “ثناء” (*sana*) can be used both for praise and criticism.

“تسبيح” (*tasbeeh*) means to be engaged in its duty with full attention.

The Quran says:

13:13	The thunder lauds Him with its loud sound	وَيُسَبِّحُ الرَّعْدُ بِحَمْدِهِ
30:18	In the highs and lows of the universe all <i>hamd</i> or praise is for Him.	وَلَهُ الْحَمْدُ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
17:22	that is, there is nothing that does not praise Allah along with performing His <i>tasbeeh</i>	وَأَنْ مِنْ شَيْءٍ إِلَّا يُسَبِّحُ بِحَمْدِهِ

This means that nothing in the entire universe can abstain from following His laws along with conducting His *hamd* or praise. Therefore, it means that all forces in the universe are busy in producing beneficial results that are living examples of Allah's creativity and His praise. This so much that when destructive forces are removed out of the way then that work by itself deserves praise.

As such it is said about the destruction of oppressive nations:

6:25	The oppressive nations were routed and Allah the nurturer of the universe deserves all praise or <i>hamd</i> .	فَقُطِعَ دَائِرُ الْقَوْمِ الَّذِينَ ظَلَمُوا وَالْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ
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That is why it has been said about Allah that He is “عَزِيزٌ” (*aziz*) as well as “حَمِيدٌ” (*hadeed*). This means that He is fine or delicate, as well as hard and tough (14:1). He is the remover of destructive forces out of the way to make the beneficial aspects manifest so that they become living examples of Allah's *hamd* and praise.

At another place it is said:

64:1	every sort of authority belongs to Him	لَهُ الْمُلْكُ وَلَهُ الْحَمْدُ
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He is also the fountainhead of every kind of grandeur and beauty. It is also one of the traits of the believers that they are “حَامِدُونَ” (*hamidoon*) as described in 9:112. This means that they are known to do *hamd* or sing Allah's praise, for this purpose man has been given the knowledge of the names (or qualities) of Allah, or the knowledge of natural elements, because when the *malaika* or the forces of the universe said to Allah:

2:30	we are always busy in Your <i>hamd</i> or praise (Allah's praise).	وَنَحْنُ نُسَبِّحُ بِحَمْدِكَ
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Then it was said in reply from Allah:

2:31	Adam [man] has been given the knowledge about all things in nature or in the universe	وَعَلَّمَ آدَمَ الْأَسْمَاءَ كُلَّهَا
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But this knowledge can become operational only if he keeps this knowledge under obedience of the celestial message or the *wahi*.

That is why he was told that:

2:38	the nation that follows the guidance of Allah will be safe from fear and grief	فَمَنْ تَبِعَ هَذَا لَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ
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This is the said “مَقَامًا مَحْمُودًا” (*maqaman mahmoodan*) or the happy place situation (17:79). This means a position which is completely deserving of *hamd* or praise, and that was attained by our beloved Messenger **Muhammed**. He himself was called “أَحْمَدُ” (*Ahmad*) in (61:6), which means one who was given greatly to conduct *hamd* or praise (of Allah). Some think that it means who himself is greatly praised, and this later became “مُحَمَّدٌ” (*Muhammed*) (48:26), that means one who is continuously the reason for *hamd* and praise, i.e. one who is praised for one quality after the other. The prophet of Allah was also named “مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ” (*muhammadar-rasul Allah*) 48:26 i.e. **Muhammed**, the Messenger of Allah.

The book named *Kitabul Ashqaaq* says that **Muhammed** means the one who is praised constantly, while **Mahmood** is the one who gets praised only once. The book *Aqrabul Muwarid* says that **Muhammed** means one who possesses many different praiseworthy traits.

If we deliberate on the meanings of the first verse of the Quran that is:

1:1	Allah is the praiseworthy Sustainer of the worlds.	الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ
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In the light of the above given definitions of the word *hamd* then we can see how the Quran has revealed the universal truth before man, that every creation in the universe is a season or occasion for *hamd* or praiseworthiness of Allah who is nurturing everything from its initial stages to its ultimate end. Obviously then *hamd* is not just a reason for emotional response but a living truth that is arrived at by deliberation upon things in the universe. Thus, a nation that does not deliberate upon the system of the universe cannot be able to appreciate the excellence of the Creator. How can he then hope to understand how things in the universe are praiseworthy? For example we can only appreciate an artist or painter through his works which come before our eyes in palpable form and we cannot laud his concept only. As such the Quran has as sarcasm upon those who merely want praise for themselves instead of doing something constructive and then let their works be praised.

“To sing the praises of Allah” is not just a verbal praising session but it is in fact a practical program i.e. to sing praises of Allah means to give practical shape to a system in society that Allah has ordained (and that which has been manifested by the last prophet of Allah i.e. **Muhammed**) and to make it produce miraculous results such as those which the whole world instantly recognizes and appreciates and cries out that undoubtedly the God or Allah Who has given such laws to humanity following which can produce such results indeed deserves unlimited praise.

H-M-R

ح م ر

“الأحمر” (*al-ahmar*) means red. Its plural is “حُمُرٌ” (*humr*).

35:27	the layers of red color or lines	خُدَّادٌ بَيْضٌ وَحُمْرٌ
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“الجمار” (*al-himaar*) means donkey as used in 2:259. The plural is “حُمُرٌ” (*humur*).

Surah *Al-Mudassar* says:

74:50	donkeys which rear up after being frightened or disturbed	حُمْرٌ مُسْتَنْفِرَةٌ
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“حَمَلَ” (*hamal*), “يَحْمِلُ” (*yahmil*), “حَمْلًا” (*hamla*), all mean to lift a burden, or carry a burden, to be laden with.

“اِحْتَمَلَ” (*ihtamal*) means to lift.

“الْحَمْلَةُ” (*al-hamalah*) means to revert in battle and attack {*T*}.

“حَمَلَ” (*hammal*) means to burden with, or to make one lift a burden, or to allocate some work to someone.

62:5	the people to whom the responsibility of obeying the orders of the <i>Taurah</i> was designated	مَثَلُ الَّذِينَ حُمِّلُوا التَّوْرَةَ
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“اِحْتَمَلَ” (*ihtamal*) means to burden oneself with as in 4:112.

“حَمُولَةٌ” (*hamulatun*) means an animal for lifting burden {*T*}.

6:143	And some of these animals are to carry burden while others to eat	وَمِنَ الْأَنْعَامِ حَمُولَةٌ وَفَرَسًا كُلُوا
111:4	one who snitches { <i>T</i> }	حَمَّالَةَ الْخَطْبِ

Hence, it means someone who passes information unnecessarily from one to another, one who gathers information for opposing.

“حَمَلَ” (*hamala*) means to make someone leave his place of seating, i.e. to destroy him {*M*}.

69:14	the earth carries the burden of the mountains	وَحُمِّلَتِ الْأَرْضُ وَالْجِبَالُ
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“حَمَلَ الْأَمَانَةَ” (*hamala al-amanata*) means to misappropriate in that which is entrusted {*T*, *M*}.

Surah *Al-Azaab* says:

33:72	We presented the <i>amana</i> or that which was to be kept safe to the sky, the earth and to the mountains but they all refused and became afraid lest there be some misappropriation in it, but man does misappropriate in it; he is very oppressive and foolish	إِنَّا عَرَضْنَا الْأَمَانَةَ عَلَى السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَالْجِبَالِ فَأَبَيْنَ أَنْ يَحْمِلْنَهَا وَأَشْفَقْنَ مِنْهَا وَحَمَلَهَا الْإِنْسَانُ إِنَّهُ كَانَ ظَلُومًا جَهُولًا
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This means that Allah presented His laws to be kept safe to the universe but it did not do any misappropriation in it i.e. the entire universe is engaged faithfully in carrying out the orders of Allah as He has ordered them to but man does misappropriate in these laws i.e. he does not carry them out faithfully i.e. does not follow them faithfully, he is very foolish and is oppressive to himself by being foolish and committing this misappropriation.

Surah *Al-Anka'buut* says:

26:60	How many animals aren't there who carry their own needs?	وَكَاَمَنْ ذَاتِةً لَا تَحْمِلُ رِزْقَهَا
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The author of the book *Taj-ul-Uroos* says that here “حمل رزق” (*hamala rizq*) means to hoard {*T*, *M*}. The Quran has pointed to a very important reality here. To hoard is inherent within human nature but not within animals. The hoarding that we see ants and mice indulge in is only due to their habits, as research has shown us, and not due to a purpose.

Besides, whatever they hoard is used by all of them and not just an individual. They do not hoard so that they can sell it at a higher price or to earn more profit as humans do. When a cow has eaten its fill, then it does not hoard the left over feed for the evening. Only humans can do this. It is this greed for more that has become the cause of such conflict in human society. The strong or the clever ones hoard the wealth etc. and the poor and the weak suffer deprivation.

The Quran says:

29:60	Allah provides for the animals (who do not hoard), as well for the humans (who do hoard)	اللَّهُ يَرْزُقُهَا وَإِيَّاكُمْ
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Animals only fulfill their need but you [man] indulge in hoarding for making a profit. This is caused chaos in human society. Details can be found in my book *Nizami Rabubiyat*.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:176	As example of a dog, if you attack him, he lolls out his tongue, or if you leave him, he lolls out his tongue	كَمَثَلِ الْكَلْبِ إِنْ تَحْمِلْ عَلَيْهِ يَلْهَثْ أَوْ تَتْرُكْهُ يَلْهَثْ
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“حَمَلَهُ عَلَى” (*hamalal aala*) means to tire out someone by making him walk too much {T, M}. As such the verse would mean that if you tire out a dog by making him run, he will pant but even if you don’t, he will pant nevertheless. This means it cannot be at rest in any condition, and it will pant in any case. Or it could be from “حَمَلَهُ عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*hamalahu alal amr*) which means that he was instigated {T, M}. Like a dog is told to go after the hunted bird or animal, that is, no matter whether you sic a dog onto the hunt or let him stay still or sit idle, he will continue to pant. Most scholars have said that “حَمَلَ عَلَيْهِ” (*hamalal alaih*) means to attack, to drive away or to dismiss someone.

H-M-M

ح م م

“حَمَّ التَّنُّورَ حَمًّا” (*hammat tannura hamma*) means that he warmed up the *tandoor* oven. That is traditional among the Arabs and is used for baking bread or *naan* and is fixed in the ground, by putting fuel into it.
 “حَمَّ الشَّحْمَةَ” (*hammash shah-mah*) means that he melted the fat.
 “حَمَّ الْمَاءَ حَمًّا” (*hammal ma-a hamma*) means that he warmed up the water.
 “الْحُمَامُ” (*al-humaam*) means the fever of all animals or camels.
 “حُمٌّ” (*hammun*) means worry or grief.
 “إِحْتَمَّ لَهُ” (*ihtamma lahu*) means he worried for him {T, R, M}.
 “إِخْتَمَّ الرَّجُلُ” (*ihtammar rajul*) means the man could not sleep due to worry.
 “إِخْتَمَّتِ الْعَيْنُ” (*ihtammatil ain*) means without any pain, there was no closing the eyes i.e. couldn’t sleep.

About the residents of *jahannum* it is said:

6:70	that drink which turns life into a great distress i.e. great distress or punishment	هُمْ شَرَابٌ مِنْ حَمِيمٍ وَ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ
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Lataif-ul-lugha says it means both hot and cold water.

Surah *Al-Waqiya* says:

56:23	shadow of hot black smoke	و ظِلٌّ مِنْ حُمُومٍ
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“الْحَمِيمُ” (*al-hameem*) means a close relative for whom one worries, or with whom there is mutual concern and love, or the one who possesses the feeling to support his close ones and who expresses that warmth and love {T, M}.

The Quran has used this word to mean a close and sympathizing friend or associate (70:10).

“حُمَّ الْأَمْرُ” (*hummal amr*) means the matter was decided.

“حَمَّ” (*hamma*), “حَمَّهُ” (*hammahu*) means he intended to do it.

“حَمَّ اللَّهُ كَذَا وَ أَحَمَّهُ” (*hammal lahu kaza wa ahammahu*) means Allah decided it for him.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning includes to become warm or to intend.

“حَمَى الشَّيْءَ” (*hamash shaiyee*) means that thing was protected.

“كَلَّاءٌ حَمِيٌّ” (*kallun hamiyyi*) means protected grass.

“الْحَمِيُّ” (*al-hamiyyun*) means the sick man who has been prohibited from taking things that might hurt him.

“الْحَامِيَّةُ” (*al-hamiyah*) is one who protects or prevents one from hurtful actions or things. Both these things fall within the purview of support.

“حَامٌ” (*haam*) during the pre-Islamic era of ignorance, there was a tradition among the Arabs to let a camel roam free if it had made a fixed number of she-camels pregnant, just as oxen are allowed to roam free among Hindus even now. And this camel is then no more used for loading or for a lowly purpose. That camel used to roam free and eat from where it wanted.

It used to acquire a sort of superstitious sacredness. The Quran has forbidden this practice in 5:103.

56:23	the heat of the sun or the fire became intense	حَمِيَّتِ الشَّمْسُ وَالنَّارُ تَحْمِي
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The Quran says “نَارٌ حَامِيَّةٌ” (*naarun hamiya*) in 10:11 i.e. very hot fire.

“حَمِيْتُ عَلَى فُلَانٍ” (*hameetu ala fulan*) means he was angry at someone {R}

“الْحُمَيَّا” (*al-humaiyya*) means height of emotion or extreme anger {T}.

“حَمِيَ الْمَسْمَارُ” (*hamiyal masmaar*) means the rod became hot {T}.

The Quran speaks of the wealth of capitalists:

9:35	the day he will be burnt in the fire of <i>jahannum</i>	يَوْمَ يُحْمَى عَلَيْهَا فِي نَارِ جَهَنَّمَ
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“الْحَمِيَّةُ” (*al-hamiya*) means that heat which is generated in anger. This means that a man should show emotional heat to protect something that is close to his heart. If that thing is factually good then this emotion is also treated as good, and if that thing is not good then this emotion shall also not be treated as good. Before the advent of Islam, the Arabs used to be very emotional in protecting their traditions. Since most of those customs and traditions were execrable or not good Therefore, the Quran has described the emotion to protect these traditions as the “حَمِيَّةُ الْجَاهِلِيَّةِ” (*hamiyyatil jahiliyya*) in 48:26.

“إِحْمَوُمِي الشَّيْءَ” (*ah-moma ash-shaiyee*) means the thing turned black like the night and the cloud.

“الْحِنْثُ” (*al-hinsu*) means sin, disobedience {T, R}. It means to be disobedient to Allah or disobey His command.

Surah *Al-Waqiya* says:

56:37	these people used to insist upon committing big crimes or infidelities	وَكَاُنُوا يُصِرُّونَ عَلَى الْحِنْثِ الْعَظِيمِ
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“الْحِنْثُ” (*al-hinsu*): to make a false promise deliberately or fail to keep a promise {T, R}. It also means to move towards falsehood from the truth {*Aqrabul Muwarid*}.

“حَنْثَ فُلَانٌ فِي كَذَا” (*hanisa fulanun fee kaza*): if he gets the strength to sin, or makes some mistake.

“بَلَغَ الْغُلَامُ الْحِنْثَ” (*balaghul ghulamul hins*) is said when a child reaches adulthood, because then he himself becomes responsible for his good deeds and bad. He then violates some command, then he himself is thought to be the criminal {*Ibn Faris*}

“تَحَنُّنٌ” (*tahan-nasa*) means to prevent one from committing some sin $\{T, R\}$.

The Quran says in the tale about *Ayub*:

38:44	(By treating your disease through superstitious means) do not leave the truth to go towards falsehood.	وَلَا تَخْشَ
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Also see heading (*Zd-Gh-Th*).

H-N-J-R ح ن ج ر

“الْحَنَجَرَةُ” (*al-hanjaratu*) means the throat {T}, or the windpipe {M}. The plural is “حَنَاجِيرُ” (*hanajir*) as in 34:10. “حَنَجَرَهُ” (*hanajarahu*) means he slaughtered him {T}.

H-N-Dh ح ن ذ

“الْحَنْزُ” (*al-hanz*) means to fry meat on warm stones and make *kabab*.

“حَنِيزٌ” (*haneez*) means the warm meat from which water is still dripping even after being fried {T}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to cook something.

Surah *Hoodh* says about *Ibrahim*:

11:69	he brought fried kid goat for his guests	عَجَلٌ حَنِيزٌ
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H-N-F ح ن ف

“الْحَنَفُ” (*al-hanaf*): the arch of the foot.

“رَجُلٌ حَنَفَاءُ” (*rijulun hanafa-o*): for the foot to be arched. This leads to the word “حَنِيفٌ” (*haneef*) which means to leave the wrong path (the curve) and to adopt the straight path.

Raghib says that “حَنَفٌ” (*hanaf*) means “to leave the path of being astray and come to the straight path”.

This encompasses the connotation of being single-minded.

The book *Tafsir-ul-Manaar* says that in the dictionary “حَنِيفٌ” (*haneef*) means to be inclined. In his time people used to follow the path of denial or “كُفْرٌ” (*kufr*), he left all the different ways and adopted the straight path {*Al-munaar*}.

The Quran after abstaining from “رِجْسٌ” (*rijs*) and “قَوْلُ الزُّورِ” (*qauluz zuur*) has said “حُنَفَاءُ لِلَّهِ” (*hunafa'a lillah*) in 22:30-31. This makes the meaning of “حَنِيفٌ” (*haneef*) clear i.e. to shy away from all sorts of worship, and go towards the laws of Allah.

“غَيْرَ مُشْرِكِينَ بِهِ” (*ghaira mushrikeena behi*), as in 22:31 means one who accepts no other obedience but His. This is what Islam means i.e. to turn away from every Godless force “يُكْفَرُ بِهَا الطَّاغُوتُ” (*yukfur bit-taghoot*), and after that to believe in the laws of Allah “يُؤْمِنُ بِاللَّهِ” (*yumin billah*) 2:256.

The above is exactly what “لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ” (*la ilaha illal laah*) means, i.e. there is no authority but that of Allah. As such, every believer or “مُؤْمِنٌ” (*momin*) is a “حَنِيفٌ” (*haneef*). This was also the way of *Ibrahim* whom the Quran has called “حَنِيفٌ” (*haneef*) in 2:135 i.e. one who turns away from all else and starts obeying the commands or laws of Allah.

“الْحَنَكُ” (*al-hanak*): some say that this means the upper inside of the mouth, but others say that it means the lower part of the mouth. However, this leads to “تَحَنَكَ فُلَانٌ” (*tahanaka fulan*), which means that he took the twist of his turban from under his chin upwards.

“الْحِنَاكُ” (*al-hinak*) means the bind with which the prisoner is held, so that if he even pulls a little on it, it may cause him pain in his chin {*T, F*}.

Animals (horses, donkeys etc.) are usually held by a leash but if a leash is not available then a rope is passed through their mouths so that it can be held and directed according to the owner’s wishes.

This is called “إِحْتِنَاكُ” (*ihtinak*). The Arabs say “لَمْ أَجِدْ لِي جَاماً فَاحْتَنَكْتُ ذَائِبِي” (*lum ajid lijama fahtanakta da abbani*) that is, since I found no leash so I put a rope in my animal’s mouth to control it. This has led to “إِحْتَنَكَ الْجَرَادُ الْأَرْضَ” (*ahtanakal jaradul ard*) which means the tad-flies swarmed over the land and sucked away all the produce.

“إِسْتَحْنَكَ الْعِضَاءُ” (*is-tahnakal iza-a*) means that a bush was uprooted.

The Quran says that *Iblees* has challenged that “لَا حَتِيكُنْ ذُرِّيَّتِي” (*lahtakinna zurriyatehi*) in 17:62, which means that I will surely tie a rope through a man’s mouth. This means put him on a leash and in this way guide him where I want.

In this there is implied the meaning not only that *Iblees* will drive Man to go wherever he pleases but it also encompasses the demeaning connotation as in “إِحْتِنَاكُ” (*ihatinaak*). Selfish ends can possess man and everyone is aware that those selfish ends serve to demean people, just as the legs of a dog follow his nose so does man follow his selfish desires and earns a bad name as a result. But if he makes these selfish emotions to be controlled by the commands of the celestial guidance or the *wahi*, then he can be greatly enriched and rewarded.

The harm which selfish ends do to a man’s character is also done by rebellious nations to weak nations. This means that they drive a rope through the weaker nation’s mouth and make it do whatever they the stronger nation wants. These strong nations are also like the devilish forces. As such the aforesaid verse was revealed 17:62. After that the Quran describes the machinations of the powerful nations into enticing the weaker nations. Details of these can be found in my book *Mafhoom-ul-Quran*.

“الْحَنِينُ” (*al-haneen*) means to be attracted towards something, or to laugh or cry intensely, or the sound of involuntary emotion whether in happiness or sadness. The author of *Misbah* says that the word “حَنِينٌ” (*haneen*) is said only of a mother’s love for its child.

“الْحَانَةُ” (*al-hannah*) means a she-camel which pangs for its child which is away in another land.

“الْحَنَانَةُ” (*al-hannanah*) also means a woman who has been abandoned by her husband and is now worrying on account of her young kids. {*T, R*}.

The Quran says about the prophet *Yahya*:

19:12-14	We endowed him with the heart of a sympathetic and loving mother	آتَيْنَاهُ... حَنَاناً مِّنْ لَّدُنَّا
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Allah’s attributes include the attribute of “الْحَنَّانُ” (*al-hannan*), but this word has not been used in the Quran itself. It gives the impression somewhat of a Christian God in its meaning of sympathy and feeling.

“حُنَيْنٌ” (*hunain*) as used in 9:25 is a valley near Mecca where Messenger *Muhammed* fought a battle with his opponents.

“حُوبٌ” (*hoob*) and “حَابٌ” (*haab*) are words used to scold a camel {T}.

“الْحُوبَةُ” (*al-haubah*) means need, a need that can drive the needy to commit a crime {R}. After that, the word also came to be used to mean a sin. It also means annihilation and worry, and also to be sympathetic or remorseful which is a necessary result after sinning {T}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is sin, need or residence.

The Quran says “حُوبًا كَبِيرًا” (*huban kabeera*) in 4:2, which means to usurp the wealth of an orphan which is a cardinal sin. It also means frustration, annihilation, misery and grief or disease {M}.

“الْحُوتُ” (*al-huut*) means fish but mostly big fish. The plural is “أَحْوَاتٌ” (*ahwaat*).

“حِيتَانَحَاوَتَهُ” (*hitanhawatahu*) means he deceives like a fish deceives.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to deceive i.e. change course suddenly which deceives the onlooker.

It is for this reason that the fish is called “حُوتٌ” (*huut*).

“حَاتَ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*haata alash shaiyee*) means to revolve around something {L}.

The Quran says about the *Yunus*:

37:142	the big fish made him its mouthful, or that the big fish swallowed him (literal meaning)	فَالْتَقَمَهُ الْحُوتُ
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Surah *Al-Airaaf* says

7:163	that is, their fish	حِيتَانُهُمْ
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“الْحَاجَةُ” (*al-hajatu*) or “الْحَاجِجَةُ” (*al-haija*) means need. Actually, it means not being able to reach one’s objective, or not being able to reach one’s desired destination. Later this word began to be used commonly to mean need.

“الْحَاجَةُ” (*al-hajatu*): the fishing tackle.

“الْحَاجَةُ” (*al-hajatu*): a need which embeds itself in a man’s heart like a tackle {M}.

Ibn Faris says it means to become very moved about acquiring something.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:68	this was a pang in <i>Yaqub</i> ’s heart (which was later fulfilled)	إِلَّا حَاجَةً فِي نَفْسِ يَعْقُوبَ
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Surah *Momineen* says this word has come to mean something which is desired.

40:80	that which your heart desires	حَاجَةً فِي صُدُورِكُمْ
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“الْحَوْذُ” (*al-hauz*) means to encircle something {T}. It also means to drive an animal harshly.

Ibn Faris says it basically means speed, to be speedy in some matter.

“إِسْتَحْوَذَ عَلَى كَذَا” (*istahwaza ala hala*) means overwhelmed something; became overpowering over it. “حَاذَ الْمَتْنِ” (*haazal matni*) means the imaginary line that can be ‘seen’ or imagined on a horse’s back from the neck to his tail, or the line of its spine or the place where the saddle is placed on the horse’s back or that part of the horse’s thigh that touches the tail. Both corners as such will be called “حَاذَانِ” (*hazaan*).

“الْحَوْذُ” (*al-hauz*) means for the man to walk exactly aligned between the legs behind a horse from where he can easily control the animal {R}. If this simile can be kept in mind then this verse can well be understood:

58:19	Selfish ends rode them hard and they were driven hard all their life by these emotions (instead of following the Allah’s way).	إِسْتَحْوَذَ عَلَيْهِمُ الشَّيْطَانُ
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In the same way the weaker nations are driven at the stronger nation’s behest. See heading (H-N-K).

Surah *Al-Nisa* says:

4:141	Say when you came to attack it was We who had encouraged you and given you the courage	قَالُوا أَمْ نَسْتَحْوِذُ عَلَيْكُمْ وَنَمْنَعُكُم مِّنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ
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Here “نَمْنَعُكُمْ” (*nam’na’kum*) means your enemies protected you, and “نَسْتَحْوِذُ عَلَيْكُمْ” (*nastahwiz alaikum*) means that we were dominant on you.

“حَارَ” (*haar*), “يَحُورُ” (*yahuur*), “حَوْرًا” (*hoora*) all mean to revert, to return, to be transformed from one state to another, also to be reduced after being excessive 54:14.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are a kind of color, to revert or return, to revolve.

“الْمُحَاوَرَةُ” (*al-mahawaratu*), “التَّحَاوُرُ” (*at tahawoor*) means reply to each other or retort (to return a statement) i.e. exchange of words as in 18:33, 58:1.

“الْمِحْوَرُ” (*al-mihwar*) means the piece of wood or iron around which something revolves.

“الْحَوْرُ” (*al-haur*) also means amazement and surprise. See heading (H-Y-R).

“الْحَوْرُ” (*al-hawar*) is a kind of wood which because of its whiteness also is called “بَيْضَاءُ” (*baiza’a*).

Saghani says this word “حَوْرَ” (*huur*) is based on being white. Its basic meaning is to be white. As such

“الْحَوَارِيَّاتُ” (*hawariyyaat*): the women who are fair and also less soiled than women who work.

“الْحَوَارَى” (*al-hawwari*) means flour which is the essence of ground wheat. It also means any edible thing that has been whitened or cleaned {T, M}.

The companions of Jesus have been called “الْحَوَارِيُّونَ” (*hawariyyuun*) in the Quran 61:14. Some think that they were laundrymen and that is why they were called Thus, or they were called this because of their cleanliness. But most think that they were called *hawariyyuun* because of their clean nature and pure intent.

Shamar says that “حَوَّارِي” (*al-hawwari*) means a well-wisher, however this word has come to mean the purity of thought, the sincerity of action or deed, and the best of companionship.

The author of *Al-Manaar* thinks that “حَوَّارِي” (*huwwari*) means flour as it is the essence of ground wheat. The companions of Jesus were called *hawariyyuun* because they were the selected people from among their nation and were particular persons {*Al-manarr* vol.3}.

“حُورٌ” (*haur*) is a plural word. Its singular is “أَحْوَرُ” (*ahwar*) which is masculine, while “حَوْرَاءُ” (*haura'a*) is feminine.

“الْحَوْرُ” (*al-haur*) means the white of the eye to be very white and the black to be very black and for the complexion to be very clear. It may as well mean the blackness of the eye to be so intense as to look as if it has been enhanced artificially. Men and women in whom these traits are found will all be called “حُورٌ” (*huur*).

The Quran says about *muttageen* (those who adhere to Allah's laws):

52:20 44:54	And we unite them as <i>hauri ein</i>	وَرَوَّجْنَاهُمْ بِحُورٍ عَيْنٍ
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Just as “حُورٌ” (*hoor*) is used for both masculine and feminine, so is “عَيْنٌ” (*ein*) the plural for “أَعْيُنٌ” (*a'yan*) which is masculine, and “عَيْنَاءُ” (*aina*) which is feminine.

Raghib says that “رَوَّجْنَاهُمْ بِحُورٍ عَيْنٍ” (*zawwaj nahoom bihoorin een*) means to make companions. See heading (Z-W-J). Therefore, this does not only mean to be husband and wife but also to be companion and friend.

Husband and wife are “زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*) for each other. Accordingly the Quran has also called pure women of a heavenly society as “حُورٌ” (*hoor*) in 56:22, 55:72.

Besides this, **Lane** has written with reference to various sources that “أَحْوَرُ” (*ahwar*), which is singular of “حُورٌ” (*hoor*), means pure or clean intellect. That is not cunning intellect but pure and clean intellect without cunningness. As such “مَآيَعِيشُ بِأَحْوَرٍ” (*ma yaeesh bi ahwar*) means a person who is not clean in his dealings, and does not live according to purity of intellect. As such, in heavenly life, mutual friends or companions are “حُورٌ عَيْنٌ” (*hoorun ein*), whether friends or wives will not use their intellect to deceive each other but their intellect will be devoid of such impurities.

H-W-T

ح و ط

“حِطَّةٌ” (*heetah*) means to protect, to keep safe, to safe guard, to resist, fulfilling someone's need.

“لَا زِلَّةَ فِي حِطَاةِ اللَّهِ” (*la zilta fee hiyata tillah*): May you live always in Allah's protection.

“رَجُلٌ يَتَحَوَّطُ أَخَاهُ” (*rajulun yatahaw wato akhah*): he looks after his brother.

“الْحَائِطُ” (*al-hayito*) means wall, because it protects the things inside it.

“الْمُحَاطُ” (*al-muhaat*): a place where cattle etc. are kept and which is protected from all sides {*T*}.

Kitabul Ashqa says that

“حُطَّتِ الشَّيْءُ” (*huttosh shai-a*) means to protect, and

“الْإِحَااطَةُ” (*al-ihataah*) means to protect fiercely.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to surround something.

“الْحَائِطَةُ” (*al-haita*): a chaste and gentle woman who is extra wary {*M*}.

“أُحِيطَ بِالْقَوْمِ” (*uheeta bilqaum*): the entire nation was encircled by annihilation {*M*}. That is, was destroyed.

The Quran says:

2:19	These people think there is no one to ask them what all they are doing; they are wrong, and their deeds can never	وَاللَّهُ مُحِيطٌ بِالْكَافِرِينَ
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	remain without due results.	
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God's scheme of things covers them and results of their deeds are surrounding them and they will surely be annihilated. Thus, "مُحِيطٌ" (*muheet*) includes both, the covering or protection of deeds and the annihilation due to the results of their deeds.

Likewise, it is said about *jahannam*:

26:54	verily, <i>jahannam</i> surrounds them	وَأَنَّ جَهَنَّمَ لَمُحِيطَةٌ بِالْكَافِرِينَ
82:16	they are not oblivious to Him	وَمَا هُمْ عَنْهَا بِغَائِبِينَ

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:42	his possessions, the fruits of the orchard etc. all were destroyed	وَأَحِيطَ بِثَمَرِهِ
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Surah *An-Namal* says:

27:22	he said, I have found out something of which you are unaware	فَقَالَ أَخْطْتُ بِمَا لَمْ تُحِيطْ بِهِ
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Here "أَخْطْتُ" (*ahaat*) means to have found out about something, to bring it within the bounds of knowledge.

Surah *Al-Brooj* says:

85:20	Allah is unseeingly surrounding them	وَاللَّهُ مِنْ وَرَائِهِم مُّحِيطٌ
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This means the same as said in respect of "مُحِيطٌ بِالْكَافِرِينَ" (*muheetun bilkafireen*).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:255	they cannot understand anything out of or from within Allah's knowledge	وَلَا يُحِيطُونَ بِشَيْءٍ مِنْ عِلْمِهِ
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They cannot comprehend, cannot come within the boundary of their knowledge.

H-W-L ح و ل

"حَوْلٌ" (*haul*) basically means to change, to go from one state to another and be distinguished from other things. As such the thing which is not in its former condition but undergoes change is called "حَالُ الشَّيْءِ" (*haalalash shaiyo*) or "إِسْتَحَالَ الشَّيْءُ" (*istahaalash shaiyo*) because there is a change in its condition. "مُسْتَحَالَةٌ" (*mustahalaat*) and "مُسْتَحِيلَةٌ" (*mustaheelat*) means a bent bow. It also means land which has not been cultivated for many years (i.e. it becomes uneven and does not retain its former state).

Raghib says that "حَوَّلْتُ الشَّيْءَ فَتَحَوَّلَ" (*hawwaltush shaiya fatahawwal*) means "غَيَّرْتُ الشَّيْءَ فَتَغَيَّرَ" (*ghaiyyartush shaiya fataghaiyyar*). Thus, "حَوْلٌ" (*haul*) means change. In the same manner, in Quranic verse 18:108 "لَا يَتَذَكَّرُ عَلَيْهَا حَوْلًا" (*la yadhona ainha hiwala*), the meaning of "حَوْلًا" (*hiwala*) is of change and transformation.

"حَوَالُ الدَّهْرِ" (*hawalud dahar*): the changes of time.

Raghib says "حَالٌ" (*haal*): the changes in one's possessions, body or in his psyche.

"أَلْحَالُ" (*al-haal*): the present time.

"حَوْلٌ" (*hawal*): to be cross eyed because the eye is not in its former (original) state.

"حَوْلٌ" (*hiwal*): decline or death. This also has an element of change.

Ibn Faris says it basically means the movement of the times.

“حَوْلٌ” (*haul*) also means the year, because it happens due to the revolution of the earth (2:240).

“أَحَالُ الشَّيْءِ” (*ahaalush shaiyi*) means the thing passed one year, or the thing is one years old.

“أَلْحَوْلِيُّ” (*al-hauliyyo*) is a four legged animal which is one year old.

“حَوْلٌ” (*haul*) also means the surroundings.

“حَوْلُ الشَّيْءِ” (*haulush shaiyi*) means the end of a thing or the side.

“حَوَالَيْكَ” (*hawalaika*) and “حَوْلَيْكَ” (*haulaiika*) are the ends which surround you.

“مَاحَوْلُ الشَّيْءِ” (*mahaulash shaiyi*) means the surroundings of a thing {T}.

“حَالٌ بَيْنَهُمَا” (*haala bainuhuma*) is something which intervenes between two things (34:54). That which intervenes is called “جَوَالٌ” (*hiwaal*) or “حَوْلٌ” (*hawal*) or “حُوَالٌ” (*huwal*).

“تَحْوِيلٌ” (*tehweel*) means to change something’s direction or to deteriorate something (17:56) {T}.

Therefore, it also means to deteriorate and to change from one state to another {M}.

“أَلْحَوَالَةُ” (*al-hawalah*) means to turn the direction of a canal to another direction.

“مُحَالٌ” (*muhaal*) means two opposites to be combined (which is impossible) {T, M}. It also means “باطل” (*baatil*) which is something untrue and diverted from its right direction.

“حَوْلَةٌ” (*haulah*) means spending power, observing power and authority. It also means to firmly sit on the back of a horse. Any load which one lifts on his back is also called “حَالٌ” (*haal*). It also means a child’s walker which helps him learn to walk {T, M}.

“حِيلَةٌ” (*heelah*): Expertness in observing, and sharpness of sight, the control over affairs and tact, and mastery in affairs.

Raghib says that “حِيلَةٌ” (*heelah*) is the secret manner in which one reaches a conclusion.

Urdu speakers generally use it in a negative sense, but in the Quran it is used to mean “to have the power to change things” and “to deal with matters”, as in 4:98 “لَا يَسْتَطِيعُونَ حِيلَةً” (*la yastatee-oona heelah*).

“حَوِيلٌ” (*haweel*): a witness, as well as a caretaker.

“حَوَّلْتُ لَهُ بِصَرِي” (*hawalto lahu basri*): I looked at him sharply {R}.

H-W-W

ح و و

“أَلْحَوَّةُ” (*al-huwwah*): greenish blackness, dark green, a color like iron that is reddish and blackish.

“أَحْوَاتِ الْأَرْضِ” (*ihwawatil ard*): the land became green {T, M}. **Raghib** has supported this meaning.

The Quran says:

87:4-5	God grows fodder from the earth, then it dries up and becomes blackish rubbish	وَالَّذِي أَخْرَجَ الْمَرْعَىٰ فَجَعَلَهُ خُتَاءً أَحْوَىٰ
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Fara’u has said when the grass dries up it is called “غُثَاءٌ” (*ghusa’oon*) and when it becomes old and moth eaten and black, then it is called “أَحْوَىٰ” (*ahwa*). Feminine form is “حَوَاءٌ” (*hawa’u*).

“غُثَاءٌ” (*ghusa’oon*) means garbage. See under heading (*Gh-Th-W*).

H-W-Y

ح و ي

“الْحَوِيَّةُ” (*al-hawaiyyah*): the roundness of anything, wound in a circle, like the intestine. Plural is “حَوَائِيَّةٌ” (*hawaya*), i.e. intestines as used in 6:147 {*T*}.

“حَوَاةٌ” (*Hawah*), “يَحْوِيهِ” (*yahweeh*) means to collect something, to gather within, to be owner, to surround it, to keep watch over it {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning is to collect.

As “حَيْثُ” (*heen*) points to time like ‘when’, “حَيْثُ” (*hais*) points to place i.e. like ‘where’. *Akhfush* says it also points to time, that is, it can also mean ‘when’. *Taj* and *Muheet* also support this.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:58	Whenever you want and from where ever you want, eat.	فَكُلُوا مِنْهَا حَيْثُ شِئْتُمْ
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About the ‘*jannah*’ of Adam, it is said:

2:35	eat profusely from where-ever you want	وَكُلَا مِنْهَا رَغَدًا حَيْثُ شِئْتُمَا
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The heavenly society will be such that life’s accoutrements will be available to every individual in abundance.

H-Y-D ح ي د

“حَادَّ عَنْ الطَّرِيقِ” (*haada unit tareeq*), “يَحِيدُ” (*yaheed*): he moved to one side from the way.

“الرَّجُلُ يَحِيدُ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ” (*ar rajulu yaheedo unish shaiyi*): man abstains from a thing out either of hate or fear.

“حِمَارٌ حَيْدَى” (*himarun haida*): the donkey which balks at his own shadow.

“حَيْدُ الْجَبَلِ” (*haidul jabal*): lifted portion of a mountain which is high and jutting out; hard, bent rib {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to move to one side from the path.

The Quran says:

50:19	this is the thing from which you used to balk and avoid	ذَلِكَ مَا كُنْتَ مِنْهُ تَحِيدُ
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H-Y-R ح ي ر

“حَارَ بَصَرُهُ” (*haara basaroh*), “يَحَارُ” (*yahaar*): to be blinded (temporarily) by looking at something.

“حَارَ فِي أَمْرِهِ” (*haara fi amrihi*): he could not find the right solution for the matter.

“حَيْرَةٌ” (*hairah*): actually means to be blinded by the glare (and Thus, to turn the eyes away from there).

“حَارَ وَاسْتَحَارَ” (*haara wus tahara*): to find no way

“فَهُوَ حَيْرَانٌ” (*fahuwa hairaan*): he was surprised, that is, being troubled at not finding the right path.

“حَارَ الْمَاءُ فِي الْمَكَانِ” (*haaral maa-oo fil makaan*): when water finds no outlet and it keeps revolving in the same place {*T*}.

“الْمُسْتَحِيرُ” (*al-mustaheer*): a path in the middle of a barren desert about which it is not known where it will lead to {*T*}. It also means to be troubled and go crazy over not finding a way.

The Quran says:

6:71	like a man possessed by his desires which the <i>shayateen</i> (opposition) control, and lead him astray in the world and the man is bewildered	كَالَّذِي اسْتَهْوَتْهُ الشَّيَاطِينُ فِي الْأَرْضِ حَيْرَانًا
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That is one who follows his desires and loses the way and does not know which way to go.

“حَاَزَ الشَّيْءَ يَحُوزُهُ” (*haazash shaiya yahuza*): to gather or collect something and take it within itself or towards oneself.

“إِنْحَاَزَ عَنْهُ” (*inhaaza unhu*): he moved away from it.

“إِنْحَاَزَ إِلَيْهِ” (*inhaaza ilaih*): he leaned towards him.

“تَحَوَّزَ” (*tahawwaz*), “تَحَيَّزَ” (*tahayyaz*): to wind like a snake, to wind, to move to one side {T}.

The Quran has it:

8:16	one who turns back to reach his group or party	أَوْ مُتَحَيِّزًا إِلَى فِئَةٍ
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Raghib says it means one who moves towards an open place, to an edge, to a corner. It means everything whose elements are interlocked with each other. As such “مُتَحَيِّزًا إِلَى فِئَةٍ” (*mutahayyizan ila fi'atin*) means to regroup with his own (or some other) party.

Ibn Faris says that it contains the element of surprise along with moving.

“حَاصَ عَنْهُ” (*haasa unhu*), “يَحِيصُ” (*yahees*): to move away from a thing, to run away to escape somebody
 “الْمَحِيصُ” (*al-mahees*): the place where one moves to, the place where one runs to and moves to one side {T}.

4:121	They will find no place to escape it. They will find no sanctuary after escaping.	وَلَا يَجِدُونَ عَنْهَا مَحِيصًا
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“الْأَحْيَصُ” (*al-ahais*) also means a person whose eye is smaller than the other.

“حَيْصَ بَيْصَ” (*hais bais*) means something to become very puzzling {R}, intense confusion {T}.

“حَاضَ السَّيْلُ” (*haazas sayl*): the flood arose, and its water rose and flooded.

This root basically means for something to start flow and then keep flowing.

“حَاضَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ” (*haazatil mar'ato*): a woman to bleed during menstruation {T, M}.

“الْمَحِيْضُ” (*al-mahez*): to menstruate as in 2:22. It also means the menstruation blood, or the days of menstruation, or the place from where the blood flows.

This word is also used for menstruation itself in (65:4).

Ibn Faris, however, says the red water that comes out of the *babool* tree (a sort of cactus) is called “حَاضَتِ السَّمْرَةُ” (*haazatis sumrah*). **Taj** has supported the meaning.

“حَاضَتْ تَحِيْضُ” (*haazat taheez*): to flow.

65:4	The women who for some reason have not menstruated: (that is, according to their age, they should have menstruated but due to some disease they did not menstruate)	وَاللَّائِي لَمْ يَحِيضْنَ
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“الْحَايِفُ” (*al-haaif*): something crooked or bent. It also means “one who has left righteousness”.
 “الْحَايِفُ مِنَ الْجَبَلِ” (*al-haaif minal jabal*): a portion of a mountain which juts out on one side.
 “الْحَيْفَةُ” (*al-heefah*): corner, side.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning is leaning.

“الْحَيْفُ” (*al-hayf*): to be partial while making a decision, to be unjust, to be unfair, and to be oppressive.
 “حَافَ عَلَيْهِ” (*haafa alaih*): was oppressive towards him {T}.

The Quran says:

24:50	Do they fear that Allah and His Prophet will be partial and won't do justice to them? (How wrong they can be)	أَمْ يَخَافُونَ أَنْ يَحْيِفَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِمْ وَرَسُولُهُ
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“حَاقَ بِهِ الشَّيْءُ يَحِيقُ” (*haaqa behish shaiyo yaheeq*): something encircled him {T}.

40:45	the worst type of punishment encircled the nation of Firoun (Pharaoh)	وَحَاقَ بِالِإِلَهِ الْعَذَابُ
6:10	The people who used to make fun of Allah's message were encircled by what they used to make fun of. (they were surrounded by the results of their deeds)	فَحَاقَ بِالَّذِينَ سَخِرُوا مِنْهُمْ مَا كَانُوا بِهِ يَسْتَهْزِئُونَ

Ibn Faris says it basically means for one thing to overwhelm another, to cover it and stick to it.

“الْحَيْنُ” (*al-heen*): total time, whether it is little or more.

In the Arabic language, “حَيْنٌ” (*heen*) means from a moment to infinity.

Raghib says it means the time when something is achieved.

“حَانَ الْقَوْمُ” (*haanal qaum*) means that which was desired by the nation, that time for getting it had come.
 “حَيْنٌ” (*heen*) also means period, and when it is meant to say that one thing happened after another then “إِذْ” (*iz*) is added.

For instance in:

59:84	when it is time for death, and life reaches the throat, at that time, after that, you are watching him	أَنْتُمْ حِينَئِذٍ تَنْظُرُونَ
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The Quran says:

38:3	this is not the time to run away	لَا تَحِينَئِذٍ مَنَاصٍ
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“حَيَّئَهُ” (*hayyenah*): fixed a time for it {T}.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says:

2:36	you have to stay on earth and avail of the benefits for a time, period of which or duration of which, has not been fixed	وَلَكُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ مُسْتَقَرٌّ وَمَتَاعٌ إِلَىٰ حِينٍ
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This duration will be different for various nations and individuals. The time for any nation will be fixed by its deeds. As for human presence on earth, nobody knows about that duration.

“الْحَيْنُ” (*al-heen*) also means murder and death.

“أَخَانَهُ اللَّهُ” (*ahanahi-llah*): He got killed by Allah (Allah’s laws).

“الْحَائِنُ” (*al-hayen*) is used for an idiot

“الْحَانِيَّةُ” (*al-haniya*) means alcoholic brew {*T*}.

H-Y-Y

ح ي ي

“حَيَّ” (*ha-yi*), “يَحْيَىٰ” (*yahya*), “يَحْيَىٰ” (*ya-hayyio*): he lived or became alive.

“حَيَاةٌ” (*hayaat*): life.

“أَحْيَا” (*ahyaa*): he made him alive.

“إِحْيَا” (*ihyaa*): to give life.

“تَحَيَّأْتُ” (*tahayya minhu*): he shrank from it.

Biologists say one sign of life is to shrink. Touch any living thing (insect etc.) and its first reaction will be to shrink itself, and if it is not living then it will remain as it is. This shrinking is actually due to its defensive instinct. From this the Arabs derived the meaning of this root as shrinking.

“حَيَاءٌ” (*hayaa*) also means shame, shyness and is also derived from this root because that too is displayed by stepping back a little.

A snake is also called “حَيَّةٌ” (*hayya*) because it moves by shrinking and expanding. {*T*}.

Raghib says “حَيَاةٌ” (*hayaa*) means the faculty of sensation, “مَوْتٌ” (*mout*) is its opposite.

See heading (*M-W-T*)

These different perspectives are

1. faculty of growth, which is found in animals and plants
2. faculty of sense
3. the faculty to think and act
4. freedom from sorrow
5. life after death which can be reached through life, that is the life of intellect and knowledge
6. Life which is met only by God and which has no death “الْحَيُّ الْقَيُّومُ” (*al-hayyul qayyum*).

“إِحْيَا” (*ihyaa*): to make alive.

“إِسْتَحْيَا” (*istihyaa*): to keep alive, also to make live.

But in 2:26, “لَا يَسْتَحْيِي” (*la yastahyi*) means that God has no qualms about giving this example here {*R*}.

“لَا حَيَّ عَنْهُ” (*la hayyia unhu*) means it is no bar.

“الْحَيَاءُ” (*al-haya*) means greenery as well as rain, because these are related to the land’s life.

“حَيَّ عَلَىٰ يَٰ حَيَّ” (*hayyia ala or hayyia hal*) means make haste in this work {*R*}.

“حَيَّاهُ تَحْيَا” (*hayyiahu tahayyia*): to pray for somebody’s longevity and a happy life {*R*}. It also means to salute as in 4:86 {*M*}.

“تَحْيَاتٌ” (*tahyyat*) is actually used for everlasting life {*L*}, and also to be safe from all evils and misfortunes.

“الْمَحْيَا” (*al-mahiya*) means life as life comes opposite to death in 67:2. Like this “مَمَاتٌ” (*mamat*) appears as against “مَحْيَا” (*mahya*) in 6:163.

“الْحَيَاةُ” (*al-hayato*) sometimes means soft or beneficial {T}.

“الْحَيَاةُ الطَّيِّبَةُ” (*al-hayatut tayyebah*) means *jannah* (heaven) or *halal* (permitted) sustenance {M}.

“حَيَّى الطَّرِيقَ” (*hayyit tareewo*) means the path became clear or distinct.

“طَرِيقٌ حَيٌّ” (*tareeq hayyi*) means clear path {M}.

For life after death, the Quran says “وَإِنَّ الدَّارَ الْآخِرَةَ لَهِيَ الْحَيَوَانُ” (*wa innad daral akhi-ratah*) in 64:29. Here instead of “حَيَاةٌ” (*hayah*) the word “حَيَوَانٌ” (*hayawan*) has been used which rhymes with “فُعْلَانٌ” (*fualaan*). This difference is very significant. In the Arabic language the words rhyming with “فُعْلَانٌ” (*fualaan*) have the connotation of intensity, overpowering, for something to appear suddenly, and movement and the element of being disturbed. This means that Life after death is not a link in the chain of life in this world which is governed by physical laws. Life will suddenly adopt a new form there {M}. Instead of stagnation, there will be constant movement and effort {M}.

Also see “آخِرَةٌ” (*akhiratun*) and “قِيَامَةٌ” (*qiyamatun*) which are mentioned under the headings (A-Kh-R), and (Q-W-M). Also see the word “رَحْمَنٌ” (*Rahman*) which will be found under the heading (R-H-M).

“حَيَوَةٌ” (*hayaah*) has different meanings as mentioned in the Quranic verses above.

He has also written that a snake is called “حَيَوَةٌ” (*hayyah*) because of its long life. The Arabs thought that the snake met its death only due to some accident, not biologically. This means that the life after death will indeed be a continuation of this life, but it will not be according to the physical laws, it will have other set of laws there.

But this fact must be well understood that the Quran does not call only the physical life as “حَيَوَةٌ” (*hayyah*). Real life, in its eyes, is that which attains the height of humanity, in which Man develops himself by acting upon the laws of Allah.

“الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا” (*al-hayatud duniya*) means quick benefit, instant benefits, only present benefits, that is a life which has no eye on the future. Hence, it means the physical life in which a man exists on the animal level. He does not have in mind the delightfulness of the life after death nor believes in the continuation of life (after death).

This is “الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا” (*al-hayatud duniya*). We should keep the Quranic meanings of “الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا” *hayatud duniya* and life after death in mind. Also the fact that as generally believed, life means to breathe and death means for the breath to stop. That is not so, but has a deeper meaning, and these words have been used in a wide connotation. Therefore, at every place, we must see which meaning is more befitting according to the context. As for example, when we say that that nation is dead, we do not mean that the individuals of that nation are buried in their graves. When we say that that nation is among living nations, then it does not mean that the individuals of that nation breathe. The meaning of alive and dead nations is obvious. The Quran has used these words at some places in these connotations too.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:123	And he who is dead...then We enliven him, and walk among people....	أَوَمَنْ كَانَ مَيِّتًا فَآخِيزُهُ وَجَعَلْنَاهُ نُورًا يَمْشِي بِهِ فِي النَّاسِ
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It is obvious here that life and death here are not physical and mean guidance and being led astray. This difference in the meanings of life and death must be borne in mind at every step. The messengers used to come in order to give ‘life’ anew to ‘dead’ nations with which they could achieve all the successes of life (8:24). This life can now be achieved by following the Quran, but only those who have the capacity to ‘live’ (36:70) and he who wants to escape disaster (2:2).

“خَبَاهُ” (*khahah*), “يَخْبُوهُ” (*yakhbawuh*), “خَبَا” (*khaha*) means to hide, to keep behind a veil. *Ibn Faris* says that these are its basic meanings.

“إِمْرَأَةٌ خَبَاءٌ” (*imra atun khibah*): domestic woman who hardly leaves her house.

“الْخَبِيَّةُ” (*al-khabiat*): the seeds which the farmer hides in the earth, the bounties of Nature which are hidden in the earth.

“الْخَبُّ” (*al-khub*): buried or hidden thing {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

27:25	the treasures hidden in the highs and lows of the universe	الْخَبُّ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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It means their latent potentialities, the treasures of sustenance hidden in them.

Ibn Faris says that it means vast land in which there is no vegetation.

“الْخَبْتُ” (*al-khabt*): low, vast land {*T*}.

“أَخْبَتَ” (*akhbat*): he reached the low land. Later this word came to mean softness, humbleness, to obey, to be content {*T*}.

The Quran says about the *momineen*:

11:23	they obey Allah's law	وَأَخْبَتُوا إِلَىٰ رَحْمَتِهِ
22:54	before Him, their hearts bow (become soft)	فَتُخَبِتُ لَهُ قُلُوبُهُمْ

In verse 22:34, it is said “مُخْبِتِينَ” (*mukhbateen*), which means those with softness and obedience. Before that it is said “فَلَهُ اسْلَمُوا” (*faklahu aslamu*) in 32:34, which means those who bend before Allah's laws, meaning, those who accept them with good grace.

“طَيِّبٌ” (*tayyab*): opposite of “طَيِّبٌ” (*tayyab*). See heading (*T-Y-B*) to see the meaning of “طَيِّبٌ” (*tayyab*).

“الْخَبِيثُ” (*al-khabis*): dirty, hateful and unpleasant, even if it regarding edibles, speech, actions, beliefs or thoughts.

“الْخَابِثُ” (*al-khabis*): cunning man, or useless thing {*T, M*}.

“خَبْتُ الْحَدِيدِ وَالْفِضَّةِ” (*khahasul hadeed wal fizza*): a mixture of iron and silver which is melted and separated in the oven. Hence, it may mean mixture, adulteration. “الْخُبْتُ” (*al-khub*): fornication.

Surah *Airaaf* says “خَبْتُ” (*khabus*) in 7:58. It is used for saline land which does not grow anything or if it does, then very little.

In surah *Ibrahim*, it is said “كَلِمَةً طَيِّبَةً” (*kalimatun tayyebah*) as against “كَلِمَةً خَبِيثَةً” (*kalimatun khabisah*), which has been likened to “شَجَرَةٌ خَبِيثَةٌ” (*shajaratun khabisah*), 14:24-26. It means a tree which gives no fruit, unfruitful concepts of life. Something that appears very correct but does not produce any result, and all effort is lost, although wrong concept grows very quick and has a lot of glamour (5:100), but it can never be stable, for its roots are not deep enough (14:26).

“خَبَائِثُ” (*khabais*), “خَبِيثَةٌ” (*khabisatun*) is the plural.

7:157 says that the prophet declares the *tayyebat*, or good and desirable things, as *halal*, while not good things as *khubais* and Hence, *haram*. This means that things as termed *haram*, or forbidden by the Quran are *khubais* and the things which are *halal* are the *tayyebat*. For details see headings (H-R-M), and (H-L-L).

The Quran has used the word “خَبِيثٌ” (*khabiss*) also for people who commit lewd acts as well as for the bad deeds themselves.

Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:26	<i>khabis</i> things are befitting <i>khabis</i> people	الْخَبِيثَاتُ لِلْخَبِيثِينَ
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This can however also mean that *khabis* women are for *khabis* men. The second meaning is confirmed by another verse which says:

24:3	a fornicating man can only wed a fornicating woman	الزَّانِي لَا يَنْكِحُ إِلَّا زَانِيَةً
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This is explained in *Mafhoom-ul-Quran*.

Kh-B-R خ ب ر

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of “خَبَرٌ” (*khavar*) is knowledge. As such, “خَبَرٌ” (*khavar*) must have knowledge as well as familiarity in it.

“أَخْبَارٌ” (*akhbar*) is the plural form.

“خَبَرٌ” (*khavar*) and “نَبَأٌ” (*naba*) differ only in that the last mentioned is news about a very big event and “خَبَرٌ” (*khavar*) is news about ordinary affairs.

Some lexicologists say that *khavar* is something which is copied from something, but the Quran has not used this word with this distinction.

Moosa said to his family upon seeing fire:

27:7	I will bring news about it to you	سَأَتِيكُمْ مِنْهَا بِخَبَرٍ
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“الْخَبِيرُ” (*al-khabeer*): one who knows or has the news, or one who gives the news {T}.

The Quran has used this word as one of the traits of God:

2:271	Allah is aware of what you do	وَاللَّهُ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ خَبِيرٌ
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“خُبْرٌ” (*khubr*) also means to know something as used in 18:68 {T}.

Muheet says this means knowledge on the basis of experience.

Kh-B-Z خ ب ز

“الْخُبْرُ” (*al-khubz*) means bread as used in 12:36 {T}. The real meaning in this root is to shun and kill.

“الْخَبْرُ” (*al-khubz*) means for a camel to strike the earth with his pawn.

Since bread is also made by slapping the dough in the oven with the hand, it is Hence, called “خُبْزٌ” (*khubz*), or perhaps because bread shuns or kills hunger.

Sometimes the word is used for edibles or means of livelihood *{M, F}*.

“خَبَطَ” (*khabat*) means to strike something hard, to trample something forcefully with the foot, to strike the tree with a stick and make the leaves fall.

“خَبَطَ اللَّيْلَ” (*khabat-ul-lail*): to walk at night without knowing the direction where one is going.

“تَحَبَّطَهُ الشَّيْطَانُ” (*tahabbatush shaitaan*): the devil maddened him {T}.

“خَبَطَ” (*khabat*) also means a king's oppression {R}.

“إِخْتَبَأْتُ الْمَعْرُوفَ” (*ikhtebaatul ma'roof*) means to demand a favor from someone perform {R}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* describes those who practise usury as:

2:275	these people stand like they have bitten by the snake	لَا يُقِيمُونَ إِلَّا كَمَا يَقُومُ الَّذِي يَتَخَبَّطُهُ الشَّيْطَانُ مِنَ الْمَسِّ
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This state embodies mental agony as well as a troubled heart which gives no calm to them as their hearts are afire with the greed for more wealth. If “الشَّيْطَانُ” (*ash-shaitaan*) in this verse is taken to mean the wild emotions of man, then it would mean, the man who is being mad due to his desires.

“أَخْبَلَ” (*al-khabal*), “الْخَبْلُ” (*al-khabal*): it basically means for some trouble (something amiss) to appear, such as some trouble to develop in man's limbs, or to have an attack of paralysis, or to be mad.

Zajaj says it means for something to be lost. Later, it commonly meant annihilation or loss.

“رَجُلٌ مُخْبَلٌ” (*rajulun mukhabbal*): a man whose hands and legs have been amputated {M}.

The Quran says:

3:117	your enemies will leave no stone unturned to hurt you	لَا يَأْلُونَكُمْ خَبَالًا
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This embodies all types of loss.

“خَبَتِ النَّارُ وَالْحَرْبُ” (*khabatin naaro wal hurb*): the fierceness of the battle dimmed, became calm, the flame became mild {T}.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:97	when the fire will start dying	كُلَّمَا خَبَتْ
17:97	we will stoke the fire for them to make it burn brighter	زِدْنَاهُمْ سَعِيرًا

“خَبَاءٌ” (*khibaun*): a curtain with which something is covered, and also the ear of the corn, the husk {R}.

“خَبَاءٌ” (*khab*) as used in 27:25, see heading (*Kh-B-A*).

Ibn Faris says that “خَبَوْنُ” (*khabwoon*) and “خَبٌ” (*khabun*) both mean to hide.

“الْخَتَرُ” (*al-khatr*): going back on one’s word is the worst way possible, to break an agreement and to deceive {T, M}. This is that break of agreement for which one works so hard that he becomes dead tired {T, M}. He becomes tired and weak and Hence, his limbs become weak as well {R}.
 “الْخَتَرُ” (*al-khatar*) is of the same meaning as “الْخَدَرُ” (*al-khadar*) which means such stupor as created by taking some poison or drug that is the cause of slackness and weakness in limbs.
 “رَجُلٌ مُخْتَرٌ” (*rajulun mukhatta*): a man whose limbs become slack.
 “خَتَرَهُ الشَّرَابُ” (*khattarahush sharaab*): the drink has made his limbs slack {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means laziness and madness.

The Quran says “خَتَّارٍ كُفُورٍ” (*khattarin kafoor*) in 31:32. This verse may mean a con man, or a man who has become lazy, due to lack of hard labor, or the man who is lazy in carrying out Allah’s orders.

“خَتَمٌ” (*khatum*) means to hide or cover something, to close and Hence, make something safe. As such, when land is cultivated and seeds sown, then watered for the first time, it is called as “خَتَمَ الزَّرْعُ” (*khatamuz zar’a*) by the Arabs, because after watering the mud sticks together and Thus, hides the seed which becomes safe.

The bee collects the honey in the honeycomb cells and lays a thin wax layer at the mouth to close the honey inside and keep it safe. This too is called “خَتَمٌ” (*khatum*) by the Arabs. Later, the honey itself, and the mouths of the cells too came to be called “خَتَمٌ” (*khatum*).

“خَتَمَ الشَّيْءُ خَتْمًا” (*khatamash shaiya khatma*): means to reach at the end of something {T}. *Ibn Faris* says this is its basic meaning.

“خَتَمٌ” (*khatmun*) and “طَبَعَ” (*tabo’n*) are used in two ways:

1. To put a seal on something.
2. The mark that is made by sealing,

Later on the meaning widened and it came to mean to close and stop something. This because by sealing the thing inside, one closes it and it is not brought out anymore {T}.

“خِتَامٌ” (*khitaam*) is the wax which is used to seal.

“خَاتَمٌ” (*khatamun*) is the seal itself.

“خَاتَمٌ” (*khatamun*) is also used for the end of everything.

“خَاتَمُ الْقَوْمِ” (*khatamul qaum*) would as such mean the last individual of the nation.

“خِتَامٌ” (*khitaam*) means the last part of any drink {F}.

Fara thinks that “خَاتَمٌ” (*khatamun*) and “خِتَامٌ” (*khitaam*) are very similar in meaning

“فُلَانٌ خَتَمَ عَلَيْكَ بَابَهُ” (*fulan khatama alaika babehi*): that man avoids you and closes his doors on you {T}.

Quran says:

2:7	There is a seal of Allah on their hearts	خَتَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ
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It also says “طَبَعَ اللَّهُ” (*taba’allahu....*) other places.

When it says that the hearts of people are sealed, it means that they lose the capacity to think or comprehend.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:46	If Allah take away your ability to listen and observe and seal of your heart ...	أَخَذَ اللَّهُ سَمْعَكُمْ وَأَبْصَارَكُمْ وَخَتَمَ عَلَى قُلُوبِكُمْ مَنْ
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This verse makes it clear seal on heart means to lose the abilities of comprehension. This is the condition of those who willingly adopt the wrong path, because they prefer quick benefits to the pleasantness of future (16:106-108). Then there are those who are unwilling to hear the right thing and when they are confronted with it, they turn their heads and walk away (17:45-46). Their condition is such that they attend your sittings and it appears that they are listening to you quite attentively, but they are listening to something else (they are faking that they are listening to you), and only know how to follow their desires (47:16-17) and do not deliberate on the noble Quran (27:24). Their deeds themselves turn into rust and seal their hearts {T}.

These explanations clarify what “خَتَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ” (*khatamul lahu ala qulubehim*) means. It means that it is not Allah who seals the hearts, but their own deeds, according to the laws of nature, become the seals.

In surah *Tatfeef* verse 83:25, the drink in *jannah* has been called “رَحِيقٍ مَخْتُومٍ” (*raheeqim makhtoom*), and it is said “خِتَامُهُ مِسْكٌ” (*khitaamohu miskun*) in 83:25, also with it is 83:26 which says that its will shall remain and shall be like musk. It is followed by “مِزَاجُهُ مِنْ تَسْنِيمٍ” (*mizajohu min tasneem*) in 83:27 which means that it will be mixed with water which is coming from great heights and shall give life the strength to reach the highest destinations.

Surah *Aaab* calls the Messenger (pbuh) as “خَاتَمَ النَّبِيِّينَ” (*khaataman nabiyyin*) in 33:40. “خَاتَمٌ” (*khatam*) has been explained earlier and as per those meanings it would mean that the Messenger is the last Messenger. To think that messenger-hood continues after him is against the Quranic teachings. Since the Quran is the last Book that has been revealed by God, the Messenger is also the last messenger. See (N-B-A) for the meaning of messenger where it has also been explained that there can be no messenger without a holy Book. Therefore, there was no celestial book after the Quran and no Messenger after Mohammed (pbuh).

The concept that with the messenger's seal others can also become messenger is to be unaware of the reality of messenger-hood. Messenger-hood was endowed on any man by God not due to any effort or expertise. Nobody could acquire it, nor could any messenger relegate it to anybody. Details will be found under heading (N-B-A). As such, any claim to messenger-hood after Mohammed (pbuh) is patently untrue.

But there is another form of the claim to messenger-hood which is very complex and as such demands careful deliberation. Messenger-hood is to acquire knowledge directly from God, that is, his own intellect or knowledge has nothing to do with it. He must get the knowledge directly from God. In *sufism*, there is a concept that *aulia Allah* (Allah's friends) or *Sufis* get direct knowledge from God, and that is called *kashf* or *ilhaam*. But the difference is of name only as manifested. *Kashf*, *ilhaam* and *wahi* are all the same, only the names are different, Thus, inherently this concept lays open the door to messenger-hood. According to the Quran, whatever knowledge God wished to impart, He gave to the last Messenger (pbuh). This knowledge is now safe in the Quran. Now, no human can have direct knowledge from God.

Note that *kashf* and *ilhaam* are man's own psychological tribulations, they are not from God.

“الْخُدُّ” (*al-khudd*) has been used in 31:18 for the cheek. Otherwise it means a rectangular hole dug in the ground. “الْخُدُّ” (*al-ukhdood*) means ditch {T}.

The Quran says:

85:4	Death other people of the fire-ditches	قُتِلَ أَصْحَابُ الْأُخْدُودِ
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Muheet relates that the king of Yemen, **Zunawaas**, asked able bodied Christian young men to give up Christianity. When they refused, he had a trench built and put them in it to burn in the fire which he had started there. **Taj-ul-Uroos** relates that **Bakht-Nasr** torched religious Jews like this. But the context of the Quran shows that it means all those opponents of Islam who were fighting against the God’s Messenger, and used to keep the fires of war burning. The Quran has given the news about their destruction. Also see heading **ashaabul, ukhdood** and **tubbah**.

“خَدْعُ” (*khad’a*) means hypocrisy, to secretly connive against someone {T}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to hide and keep secrets.

“خَدُوْعُ” (*khad’o*) is actually that female camel which at times gives milk profusely and at others completely dries up {L}. Arabs were famous hosts and used to live on desert and the milk and meat of their animals was readily available with them. Imagine the chagrin of the host who goes to milk a camel only to find out that she has dried up. Thus, a camel (she) which could not be relied on was called “خَدُوْعُ” (*kjhad’o*).

“خَيْدَعُ” (*khada’a*) is a mirage, and also the path which is seemingly leading to one’s destination but the reality is against it {T}.

“خَادِعَةٌ” (*khadia*) is a small room built aside a bigger room, where the valuables of the house are kept {T}.

Lataaif-ul-Lugha says that “الْخَادِغُ” (*al-khadih*) and “الْخُدُوْعُ” (*al-khuduh*) means the path which sometimes becomes very clear and at other times is completely lost.

“خَدْعُ” (*khaduh*) is that way of life in which hypocrisy is practiced or which is less than expected, or that which is not stable (not on the same condition).

“خَدَعُ الْكَرِيمُ” (*khadal karteem*) is said when a philanthropist unexpectedly turns miserly.

“خَدَعُ الْمَطَرُ” (*khada’al matar*) means when it rains less than expected.

“سُوقٌ خَادِعَةٌ” (*sooqun khadia*) means a market which does not stay stable.

“خَدَعَتِ الْأُمُورُ” (*khada’atil umoor*) means for conditions to deteriorate {T}.

“خَدَعُ” (*khada’ah*) also means to become less.

“السَّنُونُ الْخَوَادِعُنُ” (*as-sinoonal hawadeh*) are the years when sometimes there is a good crop and sometimes drought, or which years have lots of rain but little produce.

“دِينَارٌ خَادِعٌ” (*deenarun khadeh*) is that *Deenar* (Arab unit of currency) which looks okay but on scrutiny is found to be counterfeit {T}.

“خَادِعُ” (*khadeh*) means the person who in his emotions either flares up or withdraws within himself, or that hypocrite who appears as he is not only to gain some profit, and in this way he deceives the society. Such people cannot be trusted.

Muheet says “خَدَعُ” (*khada’a*) basically means secretive and hidden-ness which cannot be judged beforehand. This is the hallmark of opportunists or emotionalists.

The Quran has described this sort of deceptive mentality as the disease of the heart in 2:10 and said further that this is psychologically a deception with one’s Self, since God’s scheme of things makes them deceive themselves.

2:9	But they deceive none other than themselves	وَمَا يَخْدَعُونَ إِلَّا أَنْفُسَهُمْ وَمَا يَشْعُرُونَ
2:10	There is a disease in their hearts	فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ مَرَضٌ

Surah *Nisaa* describes them as:

4:142	these hypocrites want to deceive Allah’s laws but it so happens that they deceive only themselves	إِنَّ الْمُنَافِقِينَ يُخَادِعُونَ اللَّهَ وَهُوَ خَادِعُهُمْ
9:2	Deceiving Allah is actually self-deception	وَمَا يَخْدَعُونَ إِلَّا أَنْفُسَهُمْ

But people do not understand, because they do not have awareness about it. As it is, anyone who is blinded by emotions loses his understanding power.

“الْخِدْنُ” (*al-khidn*) means companion, one to talk to, friend {*T*}.

Raghib says this is used mostly for a companion who stays with one due to sexual desire.

Words which have “خ” (*kha*) and “د” (*daal*) together contain the connotation of effectiveness {*Al-ilm-ul Khafaaq*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to stay with someone.

The noble Quran has said about the sexual relationship of man and woman:

4:25	<i>Mohsanaatin</i> instead of <i>musafehatin</i> , and not those who take secret lovers	مُحْصَنَاتٍ غَيْرِ مُسْلِفَاتٍ وَلَا مُتَّحِدَاتٍ أَخْدَانٍ
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The meanings of “مُحْصَنَاتٍ” (*mohsanaatin*) and “مُسَافِحَاتٍ” (*musafehatin*) can be found under the heading (*H-Sd-N*) and (*S-F-H*). From there it will be clear that “سَفْحٌ” (*safhun*) means sexual relationship only for pleasure seeking, for which the Arabs used to send messages to women before Islam. That was the custom in those days.

“خِذْنٌ” (*khizn*) is secretive affairs. Both ultimately came to mean the same thing. They are mentioned separately here so that all forms of sexual relations (out of wedlock) shall be rejected, and only one form remains, which is “مُحْصَنَاتٍ” (*mohseneen*), that is, protected and in wedlock.

“مُسَافِحِينَ” (*musafeheen*) means only for pleasure seeking. This includes illegal fornication or to fulfill the custom of marriage without accepting any of the responsibilities of wedlock.

“مُتَّحِدَاتٍ أَخْدَانٍ” (*muttakhizaati akhdaan*) would simply mean illegal fornication, although the Quran has used the words in the context of slave girls, (which the Arabs used to have in those days). See heading (M-L-K). But it is commonly applicable because as per the Quran, illegal fornication is not permitted, no matter in what form.

In other words, “سَفْحٌ” (*safhun*) would be the satisfaction of sexual desires in a way acceptable to society and “خِذْنٌ” (*khidnun*) a form which the society deems impermissible. As per the Quran, however, every form of sexual intercourse would be impermissible which is against the Quranic *Nikah* (wedlock), and its purpose, which is perpetuation of the human race, whether society feels it is permissible or impermissible.

“خَذَلَتِ الطَّيْبَةُ” (*khazalatiz zabeeha*): the female deer lagged behind its herd. Such a deer is called “خَازِلٌ” (*khaazil*) or “خُذُولٌ” (*khuzool*). Usually such deer or cow lags behind due to its young one {*T*}.

“تَخَذَلْتُ رِجْلَاهُ” (*tahazalat rijlahu*): his feet got tired and he lagged behind.

Such a man is called “رَجُلٌ خُذُولُ الرَّجُلِ” (*rajulun khazulur rajul*).

“الْخُذْلَانُ” (*al-khazlaan*) is used when a man who thought to be very useful, backs out.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to back out and be helpful.

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says:

3:159	If He leaves you without being helpful, who is left there to help you?	إِنْ يَخْذُلْكُمْ فَمَنْ ذَا الَّذِي يَنْصُرُكُمْ مِنْ بَعْدِهِ
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A nation which is left un-helped by Allah's laws (resources), as against “يَنْصُرُ” (*yansur*) in 3:159, and that nation lags behind other nations, cannot be helped by others. Such an individual or nation which lags

behind others is deprived of the blessings of life (17:22). Islam means that all **Monineen** progress in union. See the word **tasalam** under heading (S-L-M). However “آلَمَ” (**ism**) means to stay behind or lag behind due to some personal weakness. See heading (A-Th-M). But if somebody due to various temptations, children’s love being the greatest attraction among them, lags behind his party, it will be called “خَذَلَّ” (**khazal**), which means to lag behind the group of **momineen** due to some personal benefit or emotion or to lag behind the nations of the world because of giving up Allah’s system of life. These are both called “خَذَلَّ” (**khazal**).

Surah **Al-furqaan** says:

25:29	The rebellious human emotions seemingly would be with one to the last, but at the time of need, give up man’s company. (such emotions are only temporary)	وَكَانَ الشَّيْطَانُ لِلْإِنْسَانِ خَذُولًا
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Kh-R-B خ ر ب

“الْخَرَابُ” (**al-kharaab**) means desolation. It is the opposite of “عُمُرَانُ” (**umraan**) or habitation, to be uninhabited.

“خَرِبَ” (**khariba**): to become inhabited.

“أَخْرَبَ” (**akhraba**): to make inhabited, to make desolate.

“الْخَرِبَةُ” (**al-kharibah**): isolated or uninhabited place.

“الْخَرْبَةُ” (**al-kharbah**): a sieve, impairment, impairment of **Deen**, doubt and blame.

Ibn Faris says it means for a corner to break off and Thus, create impairment, and to be full of holes, like a knife is blunted as its corner breaks off.

Ibn Faris says “الْخَرِبَةُ” (**al-khariba**) means hole, and “الْخُرْبَةُ” (**al-khurrah**) means the needle’s eye.

The Quran says:

59:2	they make their homes desolate with their own hands	يُخْرِتُونَ بُيُوتَهُمْ بِأَيْدِيهِمْ
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Surah **Al-Baqrah** says about the mosques:

2:114	He tries for them to become desolate.	سَعَىٰ فِي خَرَابِهِمَا
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Hence, the desolation of mosques does not just mean that they are not visited by people to pray, but also that they avoid discussions regarding Allah’s and His traits. That is why the following order is related to mosques:

42:38	Establishment of Salaat and mutual consultation go hand in hand	أَقَامُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآمَرُوا بِشُورَىٰ بَيْنَهُمْ
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This means that where there is one, so is the other. At another place it is said that the **mushrekeen** (those who involve other laws with Allah’s) cannot inhabit the mosques (9:17), because they do not obey pure or chaste divine laws.

Kh-R-J خ ر ج

“خُرُوجُ” (**khurooj**): to exit, or come out.

“الْخَرْجُ” (**al-kharj**): expenditure as against income.

“خَارِجُ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (**kharijo kulli shaiyin**): the part of everything that sticks out, or which is evident

“الْخَارِجِيُّ” (*al-kharijiyyo*): a horse which is better than its parents. It also means anything that surpasses others of its species {T}.

“خَرَجَ فَلَانْفَى الصِّنَاعَةِ” (*kharaja fulaan fis sana’ah*): somebody became an expert in workmanship {M}.

“نَاقَةٌ مُخْتَرَجَةٌ” (*naaqatun mukh-tarijah*): a camel which surpasses others and becomes an Alfa-camel {T}.

“يَوْمُ الْخُرُوجِ” (*yaumul khurooj*): A day of festivity when people come out all decked up.

“خَرَجَتِ الرِّعِيَّةُ عَلَى الْوَالِي” (*kharajatir rayiyatu alal ewaali*): when the subjects rebel against the leader and stop obeying him {M}.

The Quran, saying that God enlivens the dead land with rain, goes on to say “كَذَٰلِكَ الْخُرُوجُ” (*kazaalikul khurooj*) in 50:12, this way there will be ‘*khuruj*’. Here *khuruj* means life anew. This has been called “يَوْمُ الْخُرُوجِ” (*yaumul khurooj*) a little further on in 50:42. In the Quran, the words “قِيَامَهُ” (*qiyamah*), “سَاعَهُ” (*saa’ah*), “بَعَثَ” (*bo-as*), “خُرُوجَ” (*khurooj*) have special connotations, but all these have the elements of life anew. This life anew could be a nation’s renaissance, or for the entire humanity to stand on its own feet, or the Life after Death of an individual. All these concepts are included in the said terms and context will determine as to what they mean at a particular place.

The words “خَرَجَ” (*kharj*) and “خَرَجَ” (*kharaj*) have also been used in the Quran, as in 18:64 and 23:71. It means the sum which one takes out of his wealth and gives to others.

I have not discussed “tribute” in a jurisprudential context because the term is not mentioned as such with this word in the Qur’an.

Among the Arabs, “خَرَجَ” (*kharaj*) was the amount a slave-owner had fixed for spending towards his slave (for paying him). Later, this word came to be used for land tax. Now, every tax that the government receives from the people is called “خَرَجَ” (*kharaj*). In the beginning “خَرَجَ” (*kharaj*) used to mean the produce of the land, but later it came to mean the tax received from properties as well {T}.

“خَارِجٌ” (*kharij*): that which comes out, exits, get expelled.

“مَخْرَجٌ” (*makhraj*): the place where something gets expelled from.

“أَخْرَجَ” (*akhraj*): to take out, to give birth, to produce.

“إِخْرَاجٌ” (*ikhraaj*): to get something out, to give birth.

“مُخْرِجٌ” (*mukhrij*): the one, who gives birth, produces.

“مُخْرَجٌ” (*mukhraj*): which is born, or the place or time from which something has been extracted (17:80).

“إِسْتَخْرَجَ” (*istakhraj*): to take out.

Surah *Baqrah* uses “إِخْرَاجٌ” (*ikhraaj*) as against “كَيْمَانٌ” (*kit’aan*) in 2:72, which means to make something evident. In the same surah, it is said “فَأَخْرَجْنَاهُمَا” (*fa akhrajhuma*) in connotation to Adam’s tale: “He got the two of them out of there”, and later it says “وَقُلْنَا ابْتَغُوا” (*wa qulnah betoo*) in 2:36. It is obvious then that *khurooj* and *huboot* are different. *Khurooj* simply means to get out, while *huboot* also has a demeaning connotation. For details, see my book “*Iblees O Adam*”).

Kh-R-D-L خ ر د ل

“الْخَرْدَلُ” (*al-khardil*) means mustard.

“خَرَدَلَ اللَّحْمَ” (*khardalal laham*): he cut the meat into many small pieces {T}.

The Quran says:

21:27	equal to one mustard seed	مِثْقَالُ حَبَّةٍ مِنْ خَرْدَلٍ
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Kh-R-R خ ر ر

“الْخَرِيرُ” (*al-khareer*) is the sound of water running, or wind blowing, or the sound of an eagle’s wings in flight, or the sound of snoring.

“الْخَرُّ” (*al-kharr*) actually means to fall from a height and the sound of the fall. Later it started meaning every type of fall.

The Quran says:

7:144	Moses fainted due to the lighting and thunder	خَرَّ مُوسَى صَعِقًا
22:31	as if he fell from the sky	فَكَأَنَّمَا خَرَّ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ

This is the state of a *mushrik* (one who lives according to other laws as well as Allah’s).

Surah *Al-Furqaan* has enumerated various qualities of a *momin*. One of them is:

25:73	when the verses of the Sustainer are recited in front of them, they don’t follow them, as if they are blind or deaf	إِذَا دُكِّرُوا بِآيَاتِ رَبِّهِمْ لَمْ يَخِرُّوا عَلَيْهَا صُمًّا وَعُمْيَانًا
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Muheet says that “خَرَّ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*kharra alish shaiyi*) means to stick to one thing.

From this it is obvious that the Quran cannot be result producing if it is simply adhered to emotionally without any deliberation. The quality of the *momineen* is that their acting upon the Quran is based on careful thought. Imagine how can the Quran allow non-divine things to be worshipped or accepted without deliberation, when it even does not allow its own verses to be followed blindly and without understanding?

It says that a *momin* does not follow something without properly understanding it. It orders him to:

17:36	Do not follow something which you do not understand. Verily the sight, hearing and the heart (or mind) will all be questioned about their responsibilities.	وَلَا تَقْفُ مَا لَيْسَ لَكَ بِهِ عِلْمٌ إِنَّ السَّمْعَ وَالْبَصَرَ وَالْفُؤَادَ كُلُّ أُولَئِكَ كَانَ عَنْهُ مَسْئُولًا
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For knowledge, sight and hearing (i.e. the senses) and mind are necessary, and *momin* is one who follows Allah’s orders after having an understanding.

Kh-R-Sd خ ر ص

“الْخَرِصُ” (*al-khars*): to estimate, to form an idea, to guess without knowing something one is uncertain of.

“خَرِصُ النَّخْلِ” (*kharsun nakhal*): to guess how much dates the tree would produce.

“كَمْ خَرِصُ أَرْضِيكَ” (*kam khirsu ardika*): what is the estimated produce of your land? As such, every assumption is called “الْخَرِصُ” (*al-khars*), even falsehood {T}.

The Quran says:

6:117	These people follow their whims and their talk is mere assumptions	إِنْ يَتَّبِعُونَ إِلَّا الظَّنَّ وَإِنْ هُمْ إِلَّا يَخْرُصُونَ
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Surah *Az-Zareyah* says:

51:10	Their assumptions shall be defeated	قُلِ الْخَرِصُونَ
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Truth is based on facts and Therefore, *Deen* is based entirely on truth. No guesswork can be *Deen*. Each and every word of the Quran is safe with us. Quran’s internal and external historical evidence supports this theory. Therefore, it is truly *Deen* and the criterion for truth and falsehood.

Raghib says that to say something by guessing, even if it is true, is still an act of uncertainty.

Hence, “خَرَّاصٌ” (*kharras*) means the same as “كَذَّابٌ” (*kazzab*) or liar {*R*}.
“خَرَصَ” (*kharasa*): he lied {*M*}.

The Quran claims that those who follow assumptions shall be destroyed. As such those who follow assumptions in *Deen* will never succeed. Our current condition testifies to this.

“الْخُرْتُومُ” (*al-khurtoum*): the nose, or the front part of the nose {*T*}. It also means an elephant’s trunk {*M*}.

Sa’ab says that “خَطْمٌ” (*khatm*) and “خُرْتُومٌ” (*khurtoum*) is generally used for the front part of the face of wild animals.

“خَرَاطِيمُ الْقَوْمِ” (*kharateemul qaum*) means the leaders of a nation, because they are in the forefront of the nation. This is an allegory to being eminent.

The Quran says:

68:16	We shall disfigure his nose (i.e./ We shall demean him)	سَنَسِيْمُ عَلَى الْخُرْتُومِ
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To deface the face or nose was very demeaning {*R*}. It embodies an element of disgrace which cannot be hidden.

“الْخُرْقُ” (*al-khurq*) means to tear something up without following any principle. This is opposite of “الْخُلُقُ” (*al-khalq*) which means to do something properly and disciplined {*T*}.

“خَرَقَ الثَّوْبَ” (*kharaqas saub*): he tore up the cloth without judging.

Surah Bani Israel says:

17:37	You cannot just tear apart the earth	إِنَّكَ لَنْ تَخْرِقَ الْأَرْضَ
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This means to tear up or drill holes. Some say that it means cutting the distance (shortening it) from one end to another {*T*}.

In surah *Qahaf* it is said “خَرَقَهَا” (*kharaqeha*) with regards to making a hole in the boat (18:71).

“خَرَقَ” (*kharaq*): he lied.

“خَرَقَ الْكَذِبَ” (*kharaqal kizb*): he fabricated a falsehood.

“التَّخْرِيقُ” (*al-taharra*): to create falsehood.

“التَّخْرِيقُ” (*at-takhreeq*): to lie profusely {*T*}.

Surah *Anaam* says:

6:100	they believe in God’s progeny which is patently untrue	وَ خَرَقُوا لَهُ بَيِّنَ
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Their concept is against all factors, belief etc. It shatters the truth.

“الْخَزْنُ” (*al-khazn*) basically means to hoard something {*T*, *R*}.

“الْخَزَائِنُ” (*al-khazaanatu*), “الْخَزِينَةُ” (*al-khazeenatu*), “الْمَخْزَنُ” (*al-mazkan*) means storehouse, or the place where something is hoarded {*T*, *R*}.

“الْخَزِينَةُ” (*al-khazeenah*): something which is safely hidden. The plural is “خَزَائِنُ” (*khazayin*).

The Quran says:

6:50	I do not claim to have the treasures of Allah	لَا أَقُولُ لَكُمْ عِنْدِيَ خَزَائِنُ اللَّهِ
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“خَازِنٌ” (*khaazin*): someone who collects, or guard or protector.
The plural is “خَازِنُونَ” (*khazeenoon*) or “خَزَائِنُ” (*khazanah*).

The Quran says:

39:72	The guards will tell them	وَقَالَ لَهُمْ خَزَنَتُهَا
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Ibn Faris says the word means to safe-keep something.

“خَزَائِنُ اللَّهِ” (*kayinullah*) are those forces and treasures of the universe that have not yet come within man’s knowledge.

Kh-Z-Y خ ز ي

“خِزْيٌ” (*khizyun*) means such ignominy which puts one to shame. That is why this word is used to mean both demeaning and shame. As such, it would mean shameful and demeaning, or to disclose such faults that are shameful to disclose {T}.

In the Quran, the result of living against the laws of Allah has been related as:

2:85	shameful ignominy in this world	خِزْيٌ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا
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Surah *Taha* says “نَذْلٌ” (*nazilla*) and “نَخْزَىٰ” (*nakhza*) in 20:134. These two words have appeared together here and they mean shame and chagrin. In surah *Hijr*, this word has come with “تَفْضُحُونَ” (*tafzahoon*), in 15:69, which means shame and disgrace.

“مُخْزِي الْكَافِرِينَ” (*mukhzi al-kaafireen*): one who imparts shameful disgrace to the *kafirs* (deniers), as said in 9:2. A life of honor and dignity is *momin’s* way of life. Ignominy and disgrace is Allah’s punishment. As such, the nation which faces these in the world cannot be a party or group of *Momineen*.

Ibn Faris says that this word basically means to distance, that is, a nation which is distanced from life’s happiness, which is the worst type of disgrace.

If it is to be determined whether a nation is living according to the laws of Allah, then it should be seen whether that nation is living a life of honor, success and power, or is disgraced in comparison to other nations of the world. If this nation is not living honorably in comparison to other nations of the world, then it is not following Allah’s laws. The following should be well understood in this context. A nation which follows the laws of the universe but its cultural life is subject to its own laws, then although it does attain immediate benefits (that is, in this life) but its future is dark. The Western nations fall into this category.

A nation, which follows the laws of this universe as well as the laws of Allah, lives a successful life in this world and has a bright future as well. This is the particularity of the party of *Momineen*, but a nation which neither follows the laws of this universe nor follows the laws of Allah in its cultural life, faces ignominy in this world as well as the Hereafter. We (the Pakistanis) fall into this category.

2:85	ignominy in this world and disgrace on the Day of the Judgment	خِزْيٌ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا وَيَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ يُرْذَوْنَ إِلَىٰ أَشَدِّ الْعَذَابِ
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“الْخَسْبِيُّ” (*il-khasi*): useless and waste wool which is thrown away. Thus, this word acquires the connotation of degradation and hatred.

“خَسَأَ الْكَلْبُ” (*khasa'al kalba*): he shooed the dog away.

“خَسَأَ الْكَلْبُ” (*khasa'al kalbo*): the dog became homeless.

“الْخَاسِيءُ” (*al-khaasi-o*): the one who is shunned.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to distance, to remove.

The noble Quran has said “قِرْدَةً خَاسِيَةً” (*qirdatan khaseyeen*) in 2:65, meaning “disgraced monkeys”. See heading (*Q-R-D*).

“خَسَأَ الْبَصَرُ” (*khasa'al basaro*): the eye was surprised and tired (due to wonderment) {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

67:4	sight will become homeless and return to the eye	يَنْقَلِبُ إِلَيْكَ الْبَصَرُ خَاسِئًا
23:109	live here with ignominy and disgrace	اِخْسَتْهُوا فِيهَا

It also means to be away from life's happiness and be deprived.

“خَسِرَ فُلَانٌ” (*khaseera fulaan*) means that man was lost on the way, was killed {*T*}.

“الْخُسْرَانُ” (*al-khusraan*) means to make less, lessen, to fail.

“الْكَئِيلُ وَالْأَخْسَرُ” (*alkaila wa akhsar*): he measured less.

Some dictionary scholars say that “الْخَاسِرُ” (*al-khasir*) is a man who when giving measures gives less and while taking takes more than the measure {*T*}.

The Quran says:

26:181	measure to the full and do not be among those who give less	أَوْفُوا الْكَيْلَ وَلَا تَكُونُوا مِنَ الْمُخْسِرِينَ
83:2-3	when taking they measure fully and while giving they lessen the measure	إِذَا اكْتَالُوا عَلَى النَّاسِ يَسْتَوْفُونَ وَإِذَا كَالُواهُمْ أَؤْوَرُّوهُمْ يَخْسِرُونَ

This last verse relates a very big economic principle. Details will be found in heading (*B-Y-Ain*).

Surah *Ar-Rahman* says:

55:9	Keep the measure full according to fairness and do not measure less: also do not spoil the balance of society.	وَأَقِيمُوا الْوَزْنَ بِالْقِسْطِ وَلَا تُخْسِرُوا الْمِيزَانَ
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“صَفَقَةً خَاسِرَةً” (*safqatun khaseerah*): unprofitable trade which incurs loss {*T*}.

“الْخَيْسَرِيُّ” (*al-khaisarah*): deception, reneging, meanness, lops.

“خَسِرَهُ تَخْسِيرًا” (*khassarahu takhseera*): killed him {*T*}.

“الْخَاسِرُ” (*al-khaasir*): someone who goes missing on the way, one who gets killed, or cannot succeed {*T*}.

It also means one who suffers loss in trade.

“خُسْرٌ” (*khusr*): loss; destruction.

Raghib says that “خُسْرٌ” (*khusr*) includes both loss of material things and loss of non-material or figurative things. That is, loss of wealth as well as loss of intellect or trust, health and honor.

Ibn ul-Aarabi has said that “الْخَاسِرُ” (*al-khaasir*): a man who has lost both his intellect and wealth {*T*}.

103:2	(If) humanity (is left without Revelation, then it) would be in loss.	إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لَقَفَىٰ خُسْرٍ
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This above mentioned loss includes all kinds.

“خَسَارٌ” (*khasaar*): annihilation, loss, one who suffers loss.

“أَخْسَرُ” (*akhsar*): someone who loses the most.

“تَخْسِيرٌ” (*takhseer*): to give loss, to shun from the good things.

Ibn Faris has said that the root basically means loss and to decrease.

Kh-S-F خ س ف

“خَسَفَ الْمَكَانُ” (*khasafal makaan*), “يَخْسِفُ” (*yakhsefu*), “خُسُوفًا” (*khusufa*): that ground caved in {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it means to go deep and hide, to cave in.

The Quran says:

28:81	We buried him (<i>Qaroon</i>) and his house (destroyed him)	فَخَسَفْنَا بِهِ وَبِدَارِهِ الْأَرْضَ
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“خَسَفَ” (*khasaf*) also means to tie up an animal without food and water. This led to its meaning of being oppressive to someone. Later this word also came to mean disgrace, insult, and to be oppressive.

“الْخَاسِفُ” (*al-khaasf*): weak

“بَاتَ الْقَوْمُ عَلَى الْخَسَفِ” (*batal qaumu alal khasf*): the people spent the night hungry.

“سَامَهُ خَسْفًا” (*saamahu khasfa*): he insulted and disgraced him.

“الْخَسِيفُ” (*al-khaseef*): caved-in (adjective).

“أَخْسَفَتِ الْعَيْنُ” (*akhsafatil ain*): the eye went blind {*T, R*}.

The Quran says

16:25	Allah will bury them in the ground (destroy them)	يَخْسِفُ اللَّهُ بِحِمِّ الْأَرْضِ
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“خُسُوفٌ” (*khusoof*): lunar eclipse {*T, R*}.

“بُرْءٌ مَخْسُوفَةٌ” (*berun makhsufah*): well whose water disappears {*R*}.

The Quran says about the revolution brought about by **Mohammed**:

78:8	the moon was eclipsed, it waned (literal meaning)	خَسَفَ الْقَمَرُ
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The above verse figuratively means that the Arabs of dark ages (who had the moon as their insignia) would weaken. They will become weak, their opposition and rebelliousness would end.

Kh-Sh-B خ ش ب

“خَشَبٌ” (*khjashab*): thick wood. Plural is “خُشْبٌ” (*khushub*). The Quran has compared the hypocrites (*munafeqeen*) to “خُشْبٌ مُسْنَدَةٌ” (*khushubun musannadah*) in 63:4. That is, such wood which have been standing with support of a wall.

Muheet says that “خَشَبَةٌ خَشْبَاءُ” (*khashabatun khashbah*) is a wood which has been eaten on the inside by termites.

This means that is something which only appear to be strong but is in fact eaten up inside. **Munafiqeen** has been called so, because neither do they have intellect or the power to deliberate, nor the freshness of life. Neither is their heart in right place, nor the mind. Hence, it means something useless, despite a fake appearance.

“خَشَبَ الشَّعْرُ” (*khashabash she'r*) means when somebody recites a verse without making it presentable.

“فَحْلٌ خَشِيبٌ” (*fahlun khasheeb*) is an untrained camel.

“جَبْهَةٌ خَشْبَاءُ” (*jabhatun khashba-oo*): uneven forehead.

Ibn Faris says that it means to be hard and uncouth or rough.

“أَلَاخْشَبُ” (*al-akhshab*) means a hard, rocky mountain, also a fresh sword which is not yet smooth and shiny due to being new and unused. These meanings make it clear as why the Quran has called the hypocrites “خُشْبٌ” (*khushub*).

“خَشَعَ” (*khasha*) means the lowering of the eyes or voice.

20:108	voices will be lowered	خَشَعَتِ الْأَصْوَاتُ
68:43	their eye will be lowered	خَاشِعَةً أَبْصَارُهُمْ
68:43	disgrace will overtake them	تَرَهُمْ ذُلًّا

This makes the meaning of “خَشَعَ” (*khasha*) clear, that it means the lowering of eyes and voice due to shame and disgrace.

“خَشَعَتِ الْأَرْضُ” (*hasha'til ard*): the land dried up and there was no rain.

“خُشُوْعُ الْكَوْكَبِ” (*khushu-ul kaukab*): for the star to lower at time of setting.

“خَشَعَتِ الشَّمْسُ” (*ksha'atish shams*): the sun was in eclipse.

“اِخْتَشَعَ” (*ikhtasha'a*): to drop the head and lower the eyes {T}.

“الْخُشْعَةُ” (*al-khushah*): hard rocky plot of land which does not grow any vegetation.

“الْخَاشِيعُ” (*al-khashih*): dusty place where camping is not possible.

The Quran uses the word “خَاشِعَةً” (*khaashiah*) in 41:39 for dead land.

In surah *Ghashia*, the word “خَاشِعَةً” (*khaashiah*) has been used opposite to “نَاعِمَةً” (*naaimah*). Since “نَاعِمَةً” (*naaimah*) means green and blooming, “خَاشِعَةً” (*khaashiah*) would mean withered.

The Quran has after this said “عَامِلَةٌ نَاصِيَةٌ” (*aamilatun naasebah*) in 88:3, that is emaciated, depressed.

“خَاشِعِينَ” (*khaashe-een*) has also been used for those who bow before Allah's laws.

The Quran says the following to elaborate what it means by *khaashe-een*:

2:46	those who believe that one day they will have to meet their Sustainer, that is, they believe that they are answerable to the laws of Allah for their deeds, and Thus, they refer to His laws for every matter	الَّذِينَ يَظُنُّونَ أَنَّهُمْ مُلَاقُوا رَبِّهِمْ وَأَنَّهُمْ رَاجِعُونَ
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This is what “خُشُوْعُ” (*khushuh*) means. To bow before Allah's laws with a willing heart.

Ibn Faris says “خَشَعَ” (*khashah*) means to bow one's head.

“الْخَشْيُ” (*al-khashi*): dry plant.

“الْخَشَاءُ” (*al-khasha'a*): rocky land which does not grow anything {T}. Among the Arabs, the drying up of plants due to lack of water was very dangerous. Therefore, “خَشِيَّةٌ” (*khashiyah*) came to mean the fear of some loss {T}.

Muheet says, with reference to *Kulliyat*, that “الْخَشَاءُ” (*khashiyah*) is more intense than fear, because it has been derived from the Arab saying “شَجَرَةٌ خَاشِيَّةٌ” (*shajaratah khaashiyah*), that is, a completely dry tree which has no sign of life left. As against it, fear only means fear of some loss, because it is derived from “نَاقَةٌ خَوْفَاءُ” (*naaqatah khaufa*) which means a sick female camel who has not died. That is, there is still hope for its survival.

“الْخَشَاءُ” (*khashiyah*) also has the connotations of hope, doubt, and expectations.

As “خَشِيْتُ أَنْ يَكُونَ ذَلِكَ أَسْهَلَ لَكَ” (*khashiyatu un yakun zaalika ashal lak*): I had the hope or expected that it will be easier for you. Likewise, it also contains the connotation of knowledge, as used in 20:94.

“خَوْفٌ” (*khauf*) also means “to know”. See heading (*Kh-W-F*).

When it is taken to mean fear, it means fear that is born out of awe {*T, R, F*}.

“خَشْيَةٌ” (*khashiyah*), Therefore, means fear of the outcome of some deed (18:80), or to dislike it.

“خَشْيَةُ اللَّهِ” (*khashiyatillah*) usually means fear of Allah but the right meaning of this fear can be understood from the meaning of “خَشْيَةٌ” (*khashiyah*).

The Quran says that if Man follows Allah’s laws, his fields become green or he flourishes.

“بُيُوتُ الْمُفْلِحِينَ” (*humul muflehoon*) as in 2:5 means that his efforts become a strong tree which has its roots in the ground and branches in the sky and it bears fruit in every season (14:24). On the contrary, if life is against the laws of Allah, then the field of his efforts dries up. The feeling that if we do not live according to Allah’s laws, then our efforts will come to nothing (the fields of our efforts will dry up), is called “خَشْيَةُ اللَّهِ” (*khashiyatillah*) or fear of Allah. For more details, see heading (*Kh-W-F*).

Surah *At-Taubah* says:

9:13	You fear as to what will happen if they oppose you whereas you should fear what will happen if you oppose Allah’s laws?	أَتَخْشَوْنَهُمْ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ أَكْبَرُ أَنْ تُخْشَوْهُ
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The fear of results is the right meaning of “الْخَشَاءُ” (*khashiah*).

Further ahead the surah says:

9:24	the trade whose loss you fear	وَتِجَارَةً تَخْشَوْنَ كَسَادَهَا
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Kh-Sd-Sd خ ص ص

“الْخِصَاصُ” (*al-khasaas*) means a break or gap which may appear between two things. It also means a hole, since a break makes a thing weak.

“خِصَاصَةٌ” (*khasasah*) came to mean constriction, starvation, bad condition, need (59:6). When the vine grapes are picked, some grapes remain here or there, they are called “الْخِصَاصَةُ” (*al-khasasah*) {*T*}.

Ibn Faris has said that this root’s basic meaning contains weakness and space. Hence, “الْخِصَاصَةُ” (*al-khasah*) means deprivation and weakness in condition.

When there is gap between two things, they are separated, and Hence, “خُصُوصٌ” (*khusoos*) means to separate someone from the others and to treat him especially. As such “خاص” (*khaas*) is the opposite of “عام” (*aam*) i.e. particular against common.

“خَصٌّ” (*khasahu*), “أَخْصَصَهُ” (*akhtassahu*) means separated him from the others and treated him specially. That is, such treatment in which others were not included, as it has been used in 8:25 {*T*}.

“خَصَّ الشَّيْءُ” (*khasassun shaiyi*): something that did not become common.

“خَصَّ الرَّجُلُ خِصَاصَةً” (*khasarrajola khasasah*): he became needy and dependent on others {*M*}.

Surah *Baqrah* says:

2:105	Allah selects whom he wants for his benevolence	وَاللَّهُ يَخْتَصُّ بِرَحْمَتِهِ مَنْ يَشَاءُ
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Here *rahmat* (benevolence) means the Revelation. This means that God selects one from the common people and grants him the Revelation, which is God-given and Therefore, no amount of effort can achieve it. This is only bestowed as per God’s own program; or rather it used to be bestowed, because Revelation is not going to be bestowed on anyone now.

“الْخَصْفُ” (*al-khasf*): shoe or footwear which has equal sized leather pieces, one upon the other (the old kind of shoes). Every leather piece is called “خَصْفَةٌ” (*khasfah*).

“خَصَفَ النَّعْلَ يَخْصِفُهُ” (*khasafan na'ala yakhsefuha*): sewed two leather pieces by putting them on top of one another.

“خَصَفَ” (*khasfu*): to join, to collect, to mend, or sew.

“خَصَفَ الْعُرْيَانُ الْوَرَقَ عَلَى بَنِيهِ” (*khasafal uryaanul waraqa ala badinehi*): the naked man put the leaves on his body and put one over the other to cover his body {T}. In other words, he placed them one over another to hide their bodies {T}.

In the tale about Adam, the Quran says:

7.22	they began covering themselves by putting the leaves from the garden one over another:	وَطَفَعَا يَخْصِفْنَ عَلَيْهِمَا مِنْ ذَرَقِ الْجَنَّةِ
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This is a reference to the awareness about sex (organs) that is awareness about shame or shyness. Details about this matter can be found in my book “*Adam O Iblees*”

“التَّخْصِيفُ” (*at-takhseef*): to try hard for acquiring something which you haven't got.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for one thing to merge with another.

“الْخُصُومَةُ” (*al-khusuma*): quarrel.

“الْخَاسِمُ” (*al-khasm*): one who quarrels (it is plural as well as feminine).

“الْخَصِيمُ” (*al-khaseem*): the one who quarrels.

“الْخُصْمُ” (*al-khusm*): the corner or edge of something.

“الْخُصُومُ” (*al-khusum*): the mouth of the valleys {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

2:204	highly quarrelsome	أَلَدُّ الْخِصَامِ
22:19	these are two parties that quarrel with each other	هَٰذَانِ خَصْمَانِ

Surah *An-Nahal* says about Man:

16:4	if he is allowed to be without the light of the revelation, then he will be found to be openly quarrelsome	هُوَ خَصِيمٌ مُّبِينٌ
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Also see heading (J-D-L).

Surah *Az-Zakhrif* says:

43:58-59	these people say these things only to quarrel with you; verily they are quarrelsome	مَا ضَرَّ يُوْهُ لَكَ إِلَّا جَدَلًا - بَلْ هُمْ قَوْمٌ خَصِمُونَ
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Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says about the Jewish worshippers:

3:43	you were not there when they were quarrelling	وَمَا كُنْتَ لَدَيْهِمْ إِذْ يَخْتَصِمُونَ
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“خَضَدٌ” (*khazd*): to bend or break a damp or dry thing in such a way as to break it, but not to break it off. Sometimes it also means to cut.

“خَضَدَ الشَّجَرُ” (*khazadash shajar*): he broke the needles of the tree (and in this way eliminated the harmful element).

“إِنْخَضَدَتِ الثَّمَارُ” (*inkhazadatis simaar*): the fruits dwindled and because the juice had gone out of them, did not remain fresh.

“رَجُلٌ مَخْضُودٌ” (*rajulun makhzood*): the man who has no more argument or who becomes disabled {T}.

“إِخْتَضَدَ الْبَعِيرُ” (*ikh tazadil bayeer*): to control the camel, he resigned it and got up on his back {M}.

The Quran says about the dwellers of *jannah*:

56:28	Within there shall be <i>makhzood</i> plum trees	فِي سِدْرٍ مَّخْضُودٍ
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It means such plum trees, the branches of which seem to be breaking under the weight of the fruit, or if this is taken allegorically, such luxuries which have been freed from all impurities. See heading (S-D-R). Then it would mean immense surprise but with no trace of doubt or any sort of trouble in it (53:14).

“الْخَضْرَاءُ” (*al-khuzrah*): green color. Plural is “خُضْرٌ” (*khuzarun*) and “خُضْرٌ” (*khusur*).

The Quran says:

76:21	green silken clothes	ثِيَابٌ سُتُودٍ خَضِرٍ
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Here “خُضْرٌ” (*khuzr*) is the plural of “أَخْضَرُ” (*akhzar*).

“الْخَضِيرُ” (*al-khaziru*): greenery (6:100), green field.

“الْخَضَرُ” (*al-khazar*): to be fine and silken.

“الْخَضْرَاءُ” (*al-khazra'a*): goodness, broadness, benevolence, greenery and flourishing {T}. Since green when dark becomes blackish, Therefore, the Arabs also interchanged “أَسْوَدٌ” (*aswad*) or black as “أَخْضَرُ” (*akhzar*) or green {R}.

Ibn Faris goes so far as to say that with the Arabs, any color which is different than white has the traces of black in it.

“مُخْضَرَةٌ” (*mukhzarrah*) as used in 22:63 means that which is green.

“الْخَضِرُ” (*al-khizru*), “الْخَضِيرُ” (*al-khaziru*): the mythical *Khizr* with his eternal life who is famous as the prophet of water and who will stay alive till Doomsday, but this is only a myth as the Quran has no mention of such a being.

“الْخُضُوعُ” (*al-khuzu*) means to bow down.

“خَضَعَ النَّجْمُ” (*khaza'in najam*): the star leaned to set.

“الْأَخْضَعُ” (*al-akhza*): the man who has lowliness and bending in his neck, who has become helpless.

“خَضَعَ الْكَبِيرُ” (*khaza-ahul kabeer*): old age bent him.

“الْخَضِيعَةُ” (*al-khazee-ah*): the (soft) sounds of the flood.

“أَخْضَعَ الرَّجُلُ” (*akhza-arrajul*): the man made his voice soft.

“الْخَضِيعَةُ” (*al-khuz'ah*): a man who is humble and pleading before everyone.

“خَضَعَ” (*khazah*): he became motionless and obedient $\{T, R\}$.

“الْخَطُءُ” (*al-kha*), “الْخَطَا” (*al-khata*), “الْخَطَاءُ” (*al-khatao*): wrong, not correct, to miss {T, L}.
 “الْخَطَا” (*al-khata*) is the mistake that is made unwittingly and “الْخَطِيئَةُ” (*al-khateeah*) is a wrong committed willfully.

But *Muheet's* composer writer that “الْخَطِيئَةُ” (*al-khateeah*) could also be unintentionally and unwittingly, but “الْإِثْمُ” (*ism*) is always willful or deliberate.

The plural for “خَطِيئَةٌ” (*khateeah*) is “خَطَابَا” (*khataba*) and “خَطِيئَاتٌ” (*khateeaaah*) actually means a deed which does not produce its full result.
 “عَلَى النَّخْلِ خَطِيئَةٌ مِنْ رُطْبٍ” (*al-unnakhli khateeah min rutab*) means there are a few dates on the date palm {T}.

The Quran says:

6:81	whosoever commits uneven (bad) deeds, is encircled by his own errors	بَلَى مَنْ كَسَبَ سَيِّئَةً وَأَحَاطَتْ بِهِ خَطِيئَتُهُ
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This shows that “سَيِّئَاتٌ” (*sayyiaat*) means to be surrounded by errors, that is, after this, a man starts missing his targets. He cannot understand anything rightly. His date palms do not bear full fruit.

In verse 2:286, forgetfulness and error have been mentioned separately:

2:286	if we forget or make a mistake, then do not hold us to it	لَا تَوَاجِدُنَا إِنْ نَسِينَا أَوْ أَخْطَأْنَا
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But another verse says:

33:5	You will not be held responsible if you err (unwittingly), it is a sin if you do it deliberately	لَيْسَ عَلَيْكُمْ جُنَاحٌ فِيمَا أَخْطَأْتُمْ بِهِ وَلَكِنْ مَا تَعَمَّدَتْ قُلُوبُكُمْ
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It is evident from this that “خَطَا” (*khata*) is an error which is not committed with intent. These were the sort of errors that Ibrahim hoped God would keep him away from:

26:82	the personae which I hope will keep me safe from my errors at the time of the Day of the Results	وَالَّذِي أَطْمَعُ أَنْ يَغْفِرَ لِي خَطِيئَتِي يَوْمَ الدِّينِ
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Surah *Al-Haaqqa* uses the word “خَاطِئُونَ” (*khatey-oon*) for *jahannam* in 69:37, and “خَاطِئَةٌ” (*khate-atah*) for oppression and excesses as well in 69:9.

Surah *Al-Alaq* says:

96:16	False, erring forehead	نَاصِيَةٍ كَاذِبَةٍ خَاطِئَةٍ
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At these places “خَطَا” (*khata*) means a crime or sin which has intent and deliberation, likewise in surah Bani Israel it is said about the murder of one's children:

17:31	their murder is verily a big crime	إِنَّ قَتْلَهُمْ كَانَ خِطْئًا كَبِيرًا
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The above explanations make clear that “خَطَا” (*khata*) is also used for an unintentional mistake or error, and also for those which are deliberate. It is that error which is deliberate will be a crime or sin and answerable for. The scholars of dictionary have said that “خَطِيئٌ” (*khatee*) means to make a deliberate error, and “أَخْطَأَ” (*akhataa*) to make the error unintentionally.

“الْخَطْبُ” (*al-khatb*): to talk, some issue, condition, matter, whether big or small.
 “جَلَّ الْخَطْبُ” (*jallal khatb*): the matter blew up {T}.

The Quran says:

12:51	(the king asked) what was their matter (problem):	قَالَ مَا خَطْبُكُمْ
15:57	He said, O messengers, what is your issue?	قَالَ مَا خَطْبُكُمْ أَيُّهَا الْمُرْسَلُونَ

It certainly holds the importance of the issue:

“خَطَبَ الْمَرْأَةَ خَطْبًا وَ خِطْبَةً” (*khatabal mar-atah khatba wa khitbah*): sent a wedding proposal to a woman {T}.

“خِطْبَةً” (*khitbah*): wedding proposal (2:235).

“خِطْبَتِي” (*khateebah*): fiancée (female) {T}.

“الْخِطَابُ” (*al-khitaab*): to talk to one another, or to address to someone {M}.

“فَصَلَ الْخِطَابُ” (*fasalul khitaab*): direct talk, or to decide forthrightly. See heading (F-Sd-L).

“خَاطَبَهُ” (*khaatibah*): talked to him

“خَاطَبَهُ” (*khatabah*): to talk or deal with.

25:63	when illiterate (uncouth) or unknowing people talk to them or deal with them they say ‘ <i>salam</i> ’	إِذَا خَاطَبَهُمُ الْجَاهِلُونَ قَالُوا سَلَامًا
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That means that they said things in which they remain safe and sound from sinning or saying something hurtful (lest they say something harsh and sinful).

Ibn Faris has said that it basically means dialogue between two persons, and for two different colors to be present.

“الْخَطُّ” (*al-khatt*): a lone line in something: a narrow, unclear path in soft ground.

Ibn Faris says it basically means a long mark. It also means any path.

“الْخِطُّ” (*al-khitt*) the land around which it has rained but not on it: the ground where no one has landed before you.

“الْخِطَّةُ” (*al-khittah*): the plot of land that one marks as his own for building upon.

“خَطَّ” (*khatt*), “يَخْطُ” (*yakhutt*), “خَطًّا” (*khatta*) means to write, to scribe.

“كِتَابٌ مَخْطُوطٌ” (*kitabun makhtoot*): written book {T, R}.

Surah *Ankaboot* says about the Messenger (pbuh):

69:48	neither could you read any book before now, nor could you write with your right hand	وَمَا كُنْتَ تَتْلُو مِنْ قَبْلِهِ مِنْ كِتَابٍ وَلَا تَخْطُّهُ يَمِينُكَ
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This shows clearly that before the advent of the noble Quran the Messenger (pbuh) could not read or write, but later this changed. He had later learnt to read and write. Therefore, the belief that he was an illiterate all his life is not correct according to the Quran.

“خَطَفَ” (*khatf*): to snatch or grab something quickly.
 “خَاطِفُ ظِلِّهِ” (*khaatifu zillehi*): a bird which swoops down in water upon seeing its shadow, to snatch it.
 {T}
 “خُطَّافٌ” (*khuttaaf*): a black colored bird which swoops down in its flight {T}.
 “الْخَاطِفُ” (*al-khaatif*): the arrow which drags along the ground and hits the target, as if it is snatching something from the ground. Hence, the following meaning:
 “الْخَاطِفَةُ” (*al-khateefah*): a girl who runs away with someone {T}.

The Quran says:

2:20	The lightning nearly snatches their eyesight. (It nearly blinds them).	يَكَادُ الْبَرْقُ يُخَطِفُ أَبْصَارَهُمْ
22:31	the bird flew away with it	فَتَخَطَّفَهُ الطَّيْرُ
37:10	excepting if somebody snatches some bit of conversation or information:	إِلَّا مَنْ خَطَفَ الْخُطْفَةَ
29:67	We made the place where Haram is, a place of peace although people from around it are snatched away	جَعَلْنَا حَرَمًا آمِنًا وَيُتَخَطَّفُ النَّاسُ مِنْ حَوْلِهِمْ

“خَطِفَ الْخُطْفَةَ” (*khatefal khatfatah*) has been used in 37:10 and “اسْتَرْقَ السَّمْعَ” (*istaraqas sama'a*) is from 15:18. The meaning is to snatch some bits of unimportant conversation or information and to eavesdrop a little. See heading (*S-R-Q*).

This is about those astrologers who claimed to know about the unknown, and still do in places where the light of Islam has not reached. The Quran says they simply employ guesswork. If something is by chance proven right, then they highlight it. Whichever is proven wrong, they find reasons for it. Besides this, they have no access to the unknown.

37:8	They may not listen.	لَا يَسْمَعُونَ
26:212	Indeed they have lost their ability to listen	إِنَّهُمْ عَنِ السَّمْعِ لَمَعْزُولُونَ

After the revelation of the Quran was the dawn of the era of knowledge and vision. These concepts get fiery whiplashes from God's kingdom. More details will be found in the relevant headings.

“الْخُطْوَةُ” (*al-khutwah*) and “الْكَطْوَةُ” (*al-katwah*) means distance between one foot and another in a step, in other words, a pace. Plural is “خُطَا” (*khutan*) or “خُطَوَاتٌ” (*khutuwaat*). Then it came to be used for a step, or for the road or path. “خُطَوَاتِ الشَّيْطَانِ” (*khutuwaatish shaitaan*) as used in 2:168 is the path of rebellious forces or the path of desires {T}. “خَطَا الرَّجُلُ يَخْطُو” (*khatar rujulu yakhtoo*): the man took a step forward.
 “تَخَطَّيْتُهِ” (*takhatiyatuh*): I stepped over him to get ahead {T}.

Ibn Faris says that “خَطُو” (*khatwun*) basically means to go ahead of something, to surpass.

“خَفَّتِ الصَّوْتُ” (*hafatas saut*): to be weak voiced due to hunger or to be voiceless.

“خَفَّتْ فُلَانٌ” (*khafata fulan*): that man died because his voice was cut off and he became soundless and motionless.

“الْخَفْتُ” (*al-khaft*): to talk secretly. It is the opposite of “جَهْرٌ” (*jahr*). See 17:110.

Surah *Taha* says:

20:103	have secretive conversation mutually	يَتَخَفَتُونَ بَيْنَهُمْ
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Ibn Faris says that it basically means to hide and keep hidden.

“الْخَفْضُ” (*al-khafz*): is the opposite of “رَفَعَ” (*raf-un*) which means to lift or make lofty. Hence, this word means to make lower, to demean.

“خَفَّضَ رَأْسَ الْبَعِيرِ” (*khaffaz raasil bayir*): he lowered the neck of the camel downwards to get on its back.

“الْخَافِضَةُ” (*al-khaafizah*): low dune.

“الْخَفْضُ” (*al-khafz*): slow speed.

“خَفَّضَتِ الْإِبِلَ” (*khafzatil ibl*): the camel slowed its speed. This led to the word meaning hospitality, calm.

“عَيْشٌ خَافِضٌ” (*aishun khaafiz*): a carefree and calm life.

“خَفْضُ الْعَيْشِ” (*khafz-ul-aish*): a life of abundance and care-freeness {*T, R*}.

The root basically contains connotation of getting sustenance without any difficulty or effort.

The Quran says:

15:88	lower your arm for those who are <i>momin</i> (take them under your wing)	وَاخْفِضْ جَنَاحَكَ لِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ
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“خَفَّضَ الطَّائِرُ جَنَاحَهُ” (*khafazut taa-iro janaha*): when a bird closes its wings to check its flight {*T, R*}. From the above meaning it could also mean that you curtail your speed so that those in your group, who are not as fast, may keep up with you. A leader has to keep the capability of his group in mind.

Surah *Al-Waaqiha* says:

56:3	that system will demean the rebels and give new heights to those who follow Allah's laws	خَافِضَةً رَافِعَةً
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Here “خَفْضٌ” (*khafz*) is the opposite of “رَفَعَ” (*raf-ah*). This means that those who are now exalted will be lowered, and those who are lower will be held aloft or that they will be reversed (11:82)

“الْخَفُفُ” (*al-kiffu*), “الْخَفِيفُ” (*al-khafeefu*): light (as against heavy).

“الْخَفَافُ” (*al-khufaaf*): light weight.

Some differentiate between “خَفَافٌ” (*khufaaf*) and “خَفِيفٌ” (*khafeef*) by saying that “خَفَافٌ” (*khufaaf*) is without weight in intellect and thought; and “خَفِيفٌ” (*khafeef*) is to be light in body: the plural is “خَفِيفٌ” (*khufaaf*) as in 9:41.

Raghib says “خَفِيفٌ” (*khafeef*) is sometimes a trait to be praised and sometimes to be condemned. This means that which is praiseworthy is “خَفِيفٌ” (*khafeef*), and which is heavy is “ثَقِيلٌ” (*saqeel*). Surface oriented and light is called “خَفِيفٌ” (*khafeef*), and heavy and weighty is called “ثَقِيلٌ” (*saqeel*).

“اسْتَخَفَّ فُلَانٌ بِحَقِّي” (*istakhafun fulanun bihaqqi*): he did not respect my right and though it was weightless.
 “تَخْفِيفٌ” (*takhfeef*): to make less, or reduce.
 “الْخُفُّ” (*al-khuff*): the leg of a camel or an ostrich: also a leather sock.

“خَفَّ الْقَوْمُ عَنْ وَطَنِهِمْ” (*khaffal qaumu un watanihim*): the people got out of their country fast and went on travel {T, R}.

The Quran says the following with regards to the desert gypsies:

16:80	you find them light weighted	تَسْجِفُونَهَا
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Surah *Ar-Rom* says:

30:60	those who do not believe in Allah’s laws, let them not take you lightly	لَا يَسْتَحِفُّكَ الَّذِينَ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ
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This means that there must not be any element in you at all, to make the opponents feel that you are light (without weight) in your claims and aims, so that removing you from your path and to follow theirs is not at all difficult.

Surah *Al-Qaariah* has used “ثَقُلْتُ” (*saqolat*) as against “خَفَّتْ” (*khaffat*):

101:6-9	Thus, the scale of those which is heavy will live a life according to his choice and those whose scale will be light, will find themselves deep in the hole of destruction	وَأَمَّا مَنْ ثَقُلَتْ مَوَازِينُهُ فَهُوَ فِي عِيشَةٍ رَاضِيَةٍ وَ أَمَّا مَنْ خَفَّتْ مَوَازِينُهُ فَأُمَةٌ هَاطِلَةٌ
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A great principle of evolution has been described here. For example, for the exam of students, a percentage is fixed as the passing mark, say sixty percent. The student who obtains 60 out of 100 marks is thought to have the capability of moving ahead. 40 percent of his mistakes are overlooked and he is promoted to the next class. This represents that the scale of his capabilities is heavier than the scale of his errors. Contrary to this, the student who obtains only 40 percent marks fails because he does not meet the criteria for going ahead. In the universe, the principle of evolution is the same. He who attains the capability to move ahead, is the one whose errors are comparatively less do not stand in his way. He who does not attain this capability, whatever little capabilities of his are found wanting, and do not do him any good. He cannot move on. Life’s evolution works on the same principle. Whoever has his scale of capabilities lower (heavier due to weight) than the other, will move on to the next stage.

The scale of whoever will be found wanting will not be able to move ahead. Those who will progress are called the dwellers of *jannah*, and those who cannot move on, have been called the dwellers of *jahannam*.

This fact has been stated at another place as:

11:15	truly, good deeds remove bad deeds	إِنَّ الْحَسَنَاتِ يُذْهِبْنَ السَّيِّئَاتِ
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If the scale with *muhsinaat* (good deeds) is heavier, then the bad effects of the rest of bad deeds are eliminated. For determining this, every scrap or iota of man’s deeds is evaluated (99:7-8), but the decision is made purely on the basis of which scale is the heavier (good or bad). If his good deeds are more, then his bad deeds are overwhelmed by the good deeds, or they do not impede or stop his progress and development, but if it is the opposite, then the good deeds, whatever they are, do not help or become the basis of his evolution. For more details see heading (*N-J-W*).

“الْخَافِيَةُ” (*al-khaafiah*): is the opposite of “عَلَانِيَةٌ” (*alaniah*), i.e. to hide, hiddenness, hidden thing.
 “الْخَفَاءُ” (*al-khafa*): that thing which is hidden to you.
 “اِخْتَفَى” (*ikhfta*), “اَخْفَى” (*akhfaa*), “اِسْتَخْفَى” (*istakhfaa*): was/became hidden;

The Quran has used the word “اِخْفَاءُ” (*ikhfaa*) against “اِبْدَاءُ” (*ibdaa*), which means to display, make evident.

2:271	If you give charity openly, it is good, but it is even better if you give secretly	اِنْ تُبْدُوا الصَّدَقَاتِ فَنِعِمَّا هِيَ وَاِنْ تُخْفُوهَا
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Surah *Al-Mai'dah* has used it against “تَبْيِينٌ” (*tabyeenun*) in 5:15. This too means to make evident.

19:3	low (hidden) voice	نِدَاءٌ خَفِيًّا
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Surah *Taha* has used “اَخْفَى” (*akhfaa*) and “سِرٌّ” (*sirran*) together in 20:7.

Surah *Al-Haqqa*, and *An-Nisa* says:

69:18	no secret will remain hidden	لَا تَخْفَى مِنْكُمْ خَافِيَةٌ
4:108	they want to hide from the people	يَسْتَخْفُونَ مِنَ النَّاسِ

“مُسْتَخْفٍ بِاللَّيْلِ” (*mustakhfin bil lail*) as used in 13:10 means which hides at night or wants to hide.

“الْخَفِيُّ” (*al-khafiyyu*): hidden, secret, which is not evident.

“طَرَفٌ خَفِيٌّ” (*tarfin khafiyyin*) as used in 52:45 means to see out of the corner of the eyes.

“الْخَفِيُّ” (*akhfiyyu*) means to disclose something, to remove its “اِخْفَاءُ” (*akhfaa*), or hiddenness {T}.

Muheet says that “خَفِيَ لَهُ” (*khafi lahu*) means to appear, and the word is used when a thing previously hidden makes an appearance, or becomes evident in some discreet manner.

Lataif-ul-Lugha says it means both “كَتَمَ” (*katam*) and “أَظْهَرَ” (*azhar*), that is, to hide and to make evident.

Ibn Faris also supports this theory about it meaning opposites.

Surah *Taha* says “أَكَادُ أَخْفِيهَا” (*akadu ukhfeeha*) in 20:15. If “أَكَادُ” (*akadu*) is taken to mean to intend here and “أَخْفِيهَا” (*ukhfeeha*) to mean make evident, then it would mean I intend to make it known or evident. If “أَكَادُ” (*akadu*) is taken to mean a negative and “أَخْفِيهَا” (*ukhfeeha*) to mean keeping hidden, then too, the verse would mean that I do not want to keep it secret, and want to make it known. In both conditions the meaning would be the same. This point has been explained under the heading (K-W-D), which must be referred to.

“خُلُودٌ” (*khulud*) means perpetuity.

Muheet, with reference to *Kulliyaat*, says that when something changes after a very long time, that is, it is not adulterated for a long time, and then this quality is known as “خُلُودٌ” (*khulud*). Therefore, it also means for something to stay as it is for a long period, whether it stays that way always or not {T}.

“رَجُلٌ مُخَلَّدٌ” (*rujulun mukhallud*): means a man who ages after a long time, while “الْبَقَاءُ” (*al-baqqa*) means to remain unchanged.

Kitabul Ashqaaq says it means longevity of life and (to remain unchanged).

“أَلْخَوَالِدُ” (*al-khawalid*) means mountains, rocks and stones because they always stay in the same state. The Arab gypsies used to collect stones and make ovens out of them and when they left, the stones were left behind. They were also called “خَوَالِدُ” (*khawalid*) {T}.

“خَلَدَ وَ أَخْلَدَ بِالْمَكَانِ وَ إِلَى الْمَكَانِ” (*khalada wa akhlada bil makaani wailal makaan*): he resided somewhere and stayed there for quite a while.

“أَخْلَدَ الرَّجُلُ بِصَاحِبِهِ” (*akhladar rajul bisaahibehi*): stayed with his companion and did not leave him.

“أَخْلَدَ إِلَيْهِ” (*akhlada ilaih*): he leaned towards him and stuck to him {T, M}.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:176	if We wished We could have granted him loftiness, but he stuck to the earth	وَلَوْ شِئْنَا لَرَفَعْنَاهُ بِهَا وَلَكِنَّهُ أَخْلَدَ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ
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Ibn Faris says it basically means stability and to stick together continuously, that is, to remain unchanged and to stick to someone.

The Quran generally says “خَالِدِينَ فِيهَا” (*khaalideena feeha*) or “هُمْ فِيهَا خَالِدُونَ” (*hum feeha khalidoon*) when it mentions *Jannah*, as in 2:25 where it refers to a heavenly society on earth. See heading (J-N-N). Then its “خُلُودٌ” (*khulud*) means that till that society is according to the laws of Allah, it will not deteriorate. But where it refers to the perpetual life, it means that Life after Death which is the outcome of good deeds. Note that the Quran has used the word “خُلُودٌ” (*khulud*) both for *Jannah* and *Jahannam*. The “خُلُودٌ” (*khulud*) of *Jannah* is eternal life, which is the life which completes its different evolutionary stages and moves ahead. And the *jahannam*’s “خُلُودٌ” (*khulud*) is the stage where human capabilities and evolution come to a standstill and life becomes unable to complete the evolutionary stages and becomes stagnant. Therefore, this “خُلُودٌ” (*khulud*) is like the mountains and the rocks. Details of these points can be found at different places in the Quran.

“مُخَلَّدُونَ” (*mukhalladoon*): the wrist and ears that are wearing jewelry. These jewelries are called “خَلْدٌ” (*khaladun*). The singular is called “خَلْدَةٌ” (*khaladah*).

56:17	Bedecked with jewelry	وَلَدَادًا مُخَلَّدُونَ
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Kitaabul Ashqaaq and *Gharibul Quran* also support these meanings.

“أَخْلَدَ” (*akhlad*): to escape destruction and bad fortune for a long time {*Gharibul Quran*}.

The Quran says the following regarding a man who collects wealth and keeps counting it:

104:3	he thinks that his wealth will save him from destruction for a long time, or give him perpetuation	يَحْسَبُ أَنَّ مَالَهُ أَخْلَدُهُ
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This is a false thought. Perpetuation is not for him who collects wealth for himself and keeps others away from its benefits, but it is for one who is beneficial to the human race.

13:17	And as for what benefits the mankind, remains in the earth	وَأَمَّا مَا يَنْفَعُ النَّاسَ فَيَمْكُثُ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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The perpetuity of the Afterlife must not be taken to mean that it is perpetuity like the eternalness of God. Absolutely not. There is no eternalness like God’s. The human perpetuity will be according to Allah’s laws. What will be its end? The human mind cannot presently comprehend anything about it. This is the reason why the Quran has along with the *khulud* of *Jannah* and *Jahannam* dispelled any thought about the infinity of God by saying “مَدَامَتِ السَّمَوَاتُ وَالْأَرْضُ” (*madamatis samawaatu fil ard*) in (11:107-108). For the meaning of “إِلَّا مَا شَاءَ رَبُّكَ” (*illa ma sha’ a rabbuka*), see heading (N-S-Y).

“خَلَصَ” (*khalas*): to be rid of all adulteration and impurities and to become pure.

“خَلَصَ مِنَ الْقَوْمِ” (*khalasa minal qaum*): he separated from the nation and became a recluse {T}.

“أَخْلَصَ الشَّيْءَ” (*akhlasah shaiyi*): made something pure; selected it {M}.

“الْمُخْلَصُ” (*akhlasu*): someone who has been separated from the others and selected for some purpose {T}.

12:24	he (Yusuf) was not one to follow the common path	إِنَّهُ مِنْ عِبَادِنَا الْمُخْلَصِينَ
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This means that he had been separated from the lot, he was to follow the right path. Likewise, it is said about his brothers:

12:80	they separated from others to have mutual consultation	خَلَصُوا نَجِيًّا
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“خَالِصَةً مِنْ دُونِ النَّاسِ” (*khaalisatan min doonin naas*): We removed the others, purely for ourselves (2:94).

“إِسْتَخْلَصَهُ” (*istakhlashu*): made him purely my own (and for none else) (12:54)

“خَالِصٌ” (*khaalis*): pure, free from adulteration.

Raghib says “الْخَالِصُ” (*al-khaalis*) and “الْصَّافِي” (*as-safee*) have the same meaning: but “الْصَّافِي” (*as-safee*) can sometimes be used for something which is already pure.

“خَالِصٌ” (*khaalis*) is that which has been purified of impurities {M}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning is to purify and separate the unwanted parts.

“الْخِلَاصُ” (*al-khilaas*) means butter, or gold and silver which is heated, liquefied and then purified.

“خَلَصَ اللَّهُ فُلَانًا” (*khallasal lahu fulanan*): God brought him out of the trouble he had landed into, just as a tangled thread is straightened {T}.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says:

2:139	we have parted from everywhere else (have become purely the followers of Allah's laws)	وَنُحْنُ لَهُ مُخْلِصُونَ
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It has been explained by “لَهُ مُسْلِمُونَ” (*lahu muslemoon*) and “لَهُ عِبْدُونَ” (*lahu aabedoon*): which have appeared in the first two verses 2:136-138 i.e. followers only of His laws.

This also explains “مُخْلِصِينَ لَهُ الدِّينَ” (*mukhleseena lahud deen*): 7:29 that is, to turn away from all other forces and reserve obedience only for God.

Surah **Saad**, after mentioning the tale of the prophets says:

38:46	We separated them from others (And made them a special group).	إِنَّا أَخْلَصْنَاهُمْ بِخَالِصَةٍ ذِكْرَى الدَّارِ
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Because of the particularity that they kept the end result in mind, that is, they kept the real life in mind (29:64), so that wherever it clashed with the temporary life, the real life was given priority over this physical life

“خَلَطَ” (*khalat*), “خَلَّطَ” (*khallat*) is to mix something with another thing, even if they can be separated later (like mixing camels in a herd of sheep) or not {*T*}.

Muheet says that “الْمَزْجُ” (*al-mazj*) means to mix liquids together and common word for mixing is “الْخَلْطُ” (*al-khalt*) {*M*}. A partner in business or trade is called “خَلِيطٌ” (*khaleet*), but *Johri* says that for one to be a partner in trade is not necessary. Those who live together without business interests and develop love for each other are also called “خَلِيطٌ” (*khaleet*) {*T*}. This means “خَلِيطٌ” (*khaleet*) is a living companion or even a neighbor. The plural is “خُلَطَاءُ” (*khulata'a*) according to (*Ibn Faris*).

“اِخْتَلَاطٌ” (*ikhtelaat*) also means intercourse.

“رَجُلٌ خَلَطَ مِلَّتَهُ” (*rajulun khiltun milt*): a man who is the product of two races.

“الْخَلِيطُ” (*al-khilt*) means a bastard {*T*}.

“خَالِطَةٌ” (*khliatah*): lived with him, intermingled.

About orphans, surah *Al-Baqara* says:

2:220	if you intermingle with them or become a partner in their trade, then remember that they are like your brethren	وَأَنْ تُخَالِطُوهُمْ فَإِخْوَانُكُمْ
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Surah *Saad* has used the word “خُلَطَاءُ” (*khulataa*) for business partner in 38:24.

The Quran says:

9:102	those who mixed good deeds with bad deeds	خَلَطُوا عَمَلًا صَالِحًا...
6:147	the (fat) that clings to the bones	مَا اخْتَلَطَ بِعَظْمٍ
18:45	That rain makes the land fertile.	فَاخْتَلَطَ بِهَلٍ ثَبَاتٍ الْأَرْضِ

“خَلَعَ” (*khala*): to get rid of something. It has similar meaning as of “نَزَعَ” (*nazaa*) but in “نَزَعَ” (*nazaa*) there is alacrity and “خَلَعَ” (*khulaa*) is slow and delayed. Some think both words mean the same.

“الْخَالِعُ” (*al-khaalio*): fallen, broken tree.

Ibn Faris says it basically means something which was together along with another part, but then got separated.

“الْخُلْعُ” (*al-khulaa*): the divorce which a woman can take from a husband {*R*}.

Surah *Taha* says God said to *Moosa* “فَاخْلَعْ نَعْلَيْكَ” (*fakhlaa fa alaika*) in 20:12. Literally, it means “take off your shoes”, but *Taj-ul-Uroos* says that it means “wait here” or “stay where you are”. Like when you tell someone you know to take off his shoes and rest for some time. Thus, this verse would mean that God told *Moosa* not to be in a hurry, and to sit calmly and listen. Now your travel (that you were roaming in search of the truth) has come to an end. Now you will find your destination easily.

Qurtubi says that here “اِخْلَعْ نَعْلَيْكَ” (*ikhlaa na'laika*) means complete your family chores i.e. put them out of your mind. He has said that the Arabs also mean family by the word “نَعْلٌ” (*na'al*) which usually means shoe.

“خَلْفٌ” (*khalf*) means behind, at the back. It also means after.

“خَلْفَى” (*khalfaka*): after you.

“الْخَلْفُ” (*al-khalf*): an era after an era (a generation after another). It also means the human beings who replace the former people, and are more than them in number.

“الْخَلْفُ” (*al-khalaaf*): the progeny, if good, will be called so. If they are not good, they will be called “خَلْفٌ” (*khalf*). But some think that these are alternate words.

Ibn Burri says that the word means progeny or a replacement.

“الْخَلْفُ” (*al-khalaaf*) is used for the generation after another or the replacement of people whether they are dead or living. In other words, it means those who remain after the annihilated ones.

Ibn Aseer says that both words mean the same, with the difference that “خَلْفٌ” (*khalaaf*) is used in a good way and “خَلْفٌ” (*khalf*) in bad manner.

Ibn Faris says there are three meanings for this root

- 1) For something to come after another and replace it
- 2) The opposite of front, that is, back
- 3) Change and amendment.

“خِلْفَةٌ” (*khilfatun*) means the leaves that appear after the old leaves have fallen. To come after another and to take its place is called “خِلْفَةٌ” (*khilfatun*).

The Quran says:

25:62	God is the One who has so created the night and day that one comes after the other	هُوَ الَّذِي جَعَلَ اللَّيْلَ وَالنَّهَارَ خِلْفَةً
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“الْخَالِفُ” (*al-khaalifu*) is a man who takes the seat or throne after the former or lags behind, or does not come together (9:83).

“خَلْفَ آبَاءُ” (*khalaafa abahu*) means that he was the heir after his father.

“الْخَالِفَةُ” (*al-khalifah*): another's heir, or the ruler who is heir after the former. Plural is “خُلَفَاءُ” (*khulafaa*) and “خَلَائِفُ” (*khalaif*) {T}.

When **Moosa** went on the mount of **Toor**, he had said to his brother **Haroon**:

7:142	you be my replacement (in my absence)	أُخْلِفْنِي فِي قَوْمِي
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Here it must be noted that **Moosa** would be absent, nobody can be a replacement in somebody's presence.

Surah **Yunus** says:

10:14	We made them their heirs after them	ثُمَّ جَعَلْنَاكُمْ خُلَفَاءَ فِي الْأَرْضِ مِنْ بَعْدِهِمْ
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Surah **Hoodh** says that **Hoodh** told his nation that if they go against God's orders then:

11:87	my Sustainer will replace you with other people	يَسْتَخْلِفُ رَبِّي قَوْمًا غَيْرَكُمْ
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This means that you will be destroyed and in your place another nation will be made your heir.

About the nation of **Aad** is said:

7:69	you were made the heirs after the nation of Nouh	جَعَلَكُمْ خُلَفَاءَ مِنْ بَعْدِ قَوْمِ نُوحٍ
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About the **Samood** nation it is said that after the nation of **Aad**, they were made the heirs (7:74).

The Quran has discussed **Adam** at several places. In verse 2:30 it is said “إِنِّي جَاعِلٌ فِي الْأَرْضِ خَلِيفَةً” (*inni ja’elun fil ardi khalifah*). This is ordinarily understood to mean that Adam is God’s deputy on earth. This meaning is inherently wrong.

Firstly, nowhere in the Quran has man been called “خَلِيفَةُ اللَّهِ” (*khalifatullah*), or Allah’s deputy. What has been said is “خَلِيفَةً فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*khalifatan fil ard*). Secondly, because we have seen earlier, that “خَلِيفَةً” (*khalifah*) means to take one’s place in his absence, that is, a successor. God is present everywhere at all times. Therefore, a successor in his absence is inherently false. He who is present himself can have no successor.

Abu Bakar was the *khalifah*, or successor of the Messenger (pbuh). This means that after the death of the Messenger, he was his successor. He was not “خَلِيفَةُ اللَّهِ” (*khalifatullah*) i.e. Allah’s successor. A person once called him *khalifatullah* after he became *khalifah*. He was corrected immediately and **Abu Bakar** said: I am the *Khalifah* (successor) of the Messenger, not Allah. {References from the book “**Abu Baker**” by author **Muhammed Hussain Hekel**, page 580 of the Urdu translation}.

Man has not come to earth to be Allah’s successor or His deputy. He has come to establish His laws and to live according to His laws.

Adam or man has been called “خَلِيفَةً فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*khilifatan fil ard*) because he replaces (is successor to) the creatures before him. See heading (**A-D-M**) and (**J-N-N**).

Since being an heir implies having authority and power, Therefore, “إِسْتِخْلَافٌ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*istakhlaafun fil ard*) means rule of a country, or the succession of some other ruling nation. Details of these matters can be found in my book “**Iblees O Adam**” where Adam has been discussed in detail.

The concept that man is Allah’s deputy is also not correct according to the Quran. Being a deputy implies to be delegated the powers. Allah does not delegate His powers to anyone. Nobody has the Divine right, neither a king nor any religious leader, not even a prophet. Allah has formulated laws by using His absolute power. Allah’s true slaves first implement those laws on self and then on the rest of the world. Man’s duty is to implement the laws of Allah. He has not been delegated the power to formulate the laws. Even the prophets simply brought Allah’s **Deen** (laws) to mankind and implemented them. They did not MAKE the laws. Therefore, they were not *naib*, or deputies in this way, but if *naib* is taken to mean one who implements Allah’s laws, then it is okay. But the word then used should not be *naib*, because the use of the word brings delegation of powers automatically to mind.

“إِخْلَافٌ” (*ikhlaaf*) means to go against a promise.

“أَخْلَفَ وَعْدَهُ” (*akhlaafa wahdahu*) means that he promised but later did not fulfill it {**T, M**}.

2:80	Allah will not break His promise (He will surely fulfill His promise)	فَلَنْ يُخْلِفَ اللَّهُ عَهْدَهُ
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“إِخْتِلَافٌ” (*ikhtilaaf*): to differ. It also means to come one after another.

2:164	the coming of night and day, one after the other	إِخْتِلَافُ اللَّيْلِ وَالنَّهَارِ
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It also means to oppose or differ.

19:37	then sects among them differed	فَاخْتَلَفَ الْأَحْزَابُ مِنْ بَيْنِهِمْ
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Some however think that “خَلَفٌ” (*khalaf*) are good children and “خُلَفٌ” (*khalf*) are bad children {**T, M**}.

The Quran says:

19:59 7:169	Then succeed after them successors	فَخَلَفَ مِنْ بَعْدِهِمْ خُلَفٌ
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“تَخَلَّفَ” (*takhallaf*): to lag behind (9:120)
 “مُخَلَّفُونَ” (*mukhalladoon*): those who lagged behind (9:81).
 “خَالَفَهُ” (*khaalafah*): opposed him.
 “مُخْلِفُوهُ” (*mukhlifooh*): those who renegade or break a promise (92:27).
 “مُخْتَلِفٌ” (*mukhtalif*): different (16:69).
 “اِسْتَخْلَفَ” (*istakhlaf*): to make one to replace the other (24:55).
 “مُسْتَخْلَفٌ” (*mustakhlaf*): heir (57:7).

God has said that the result of good deeds is “اِسْتِخْلَافٌ فِي الْاَرْضِ” (*istakhlaaf fil ard*) in 24:55. Therefore, the belief which does not enjoy authority and power is not real, and the good deeds are not really as such. To think that belief and good deeds will only bear fruit in the Hereafter, and they have nothing to do with this world, or it simply means the spiritual development of being only, which is not connected to the collective wellbeing of society, is against what Quran says.

Surah *Hoodh* says that *Shoaib* tried to prevent his people from the wrong way of life and said: “وَمَا أُرِيدُ أَنْ أَمْلِكُمْ إِلَى مَا أَنْهَيْتُمْ عَنْهُ” (*wama ureedu un ukhalifokum ila ma inhaakum unhu*) 11:88

Taj says that “خَالَفَهُ إِلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*khalifa alash shaiyi*) means to intend to do something after preventing others from it. As such, the verse would mean “I have no intention at all of doing what I am preventing you from doing”.

According to the Quran, in-fighting is a sort of punishment (3:104), and for differences to be removed a blessing (11:118-119). The Quran intends to remove the differences among people (16:64), and as such, it is also a blessing from God. Those who do not have differences deserve the *Jannah* (3:105-106).

In-fighting and differences in *Deen* are *shirk* (to mix with one another) (42:10), but this duty will be performed by the collective system of the nation (4:65). These matters are further explained in heading (*F-R-Q*). Also, see my book “*Letters to Saleem*” vol.2).

Kh-L-Q

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“خَلَقَ” (*khalq*) basically means to measure for making or cutting something, to estimate it. This is also the meaning of “تَقْدِيرٌ” (*taqdeer*). See (Q-D-R). It means to see whether it is proportionate and balanced, or to model after something, to soften and smooth out something {T, L}. It also means to make one thing out of another {R}.

“خَلَقَ الْاِذِيْمَ” (*halaqul adeem*): he measured or evaluated the leather for making something.
 “رَجُلٌ تَامُّ الْخَلْقِ” (*rajulun tammul khalq*): a man who is balanced and proportionate. It is also called “خَلِيْقٌ” (*khaleeq*).
 “خُلْفَةٌ” (*khulqatun*): smoothness, to be symmetrical.
 “اَلْخُلُقُ” (*al-khalaq*): to be free of gaps etc. and be smooth {T, L}.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meanings are to evaluate or measure something, and for something to become smooth (due to constant use). That is why old things are called “خَلَقٌ” (*khalaq*) because due to constant use, they become smooth surfaced.

Thus, “خَلَقَ” (*khalaq*) would mean to evaluate something, to create it so that it becomes balanced and proportionate, and it becomes clean and smooth.

“بَدَعَ” (*bada*) and “فَطَرَ” (*fatar*) mean to bring something from nothingness into existence, to create for the first time, to invent. Thus, “خَلَقَ” (*khalaq*) would mean to give different shapes and form to elements and to create things.

16:14	Creation of Man has been done of surfing liquid	خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ نُطْفَةٍ
55:14	Creation of Man has been done from clay	خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ صَلْصَالٍ

In surah **Hajj** the different stages of sperm, and genes in the mother's womb have been described and the Quran says that it transforms into "مُضْغَةٍ" (*muzgha*) which has two forms, "مُخَلَّقَةٍ" (*mukhallaqah*) and "غَيْرِ مُخَلَّقَةٍ" (*ghair mukhallaqah*) 22:5. "مُخَلَّقٌ" (*mukhallaq*) means complete, or which is made smooth or softened (*Muheet*).

Ibn Faris says "الْمُخَلَّقُ" (*al-mukhalliq*) is that arrow which has been straightened. Therefore, the verse can be taken to mean that "مُضْغَةٍ" (*muzgha*) is either a complete child or it remains incomplete, and is aborted.

Surah **Shoora** says:

26:137	this is the same old custom or old habit, or way of old	أَنْ هَذَا إِلَّا خُلُقُ الْأَوَّلِينَ
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Some people have said it means customs and traditions {**T, L**}. This has led to its meaning of habits and usual practices. As such, "خُلُقٌ" (*khuluqun*) is somebody's physical habits {**T, L**}, since habits are old practices, that is why "خُلُقٌ" (*khalaq*) also means ancient.

"خُلُقُ النَّوْبِ" (*khalaqas saub*): the cloth became old.

"إِنْ بَدَأَ إِلَّا خَلَقَ" (*inn haaza illakh telaq*) is a concoction used in (38:7)

"خُلُقَةٍ" (*khalaqatun*) means someone's natural constitution {**T**}.

"خَلَقَ" (*khalaq*) means estimated portion as used in 3:76.

Raghib says "خَلَقَ" (*khalaq*) means that edge which one gets due to good morals.

The Quran has also used "أَمَرَ" (*amr*) as against "خُلُقٌ" (*khalaq*), as in 7:54. See heading (A-M-R).

"خُلُقٌ" (*khalaqa*) also means to make the right estimate and to intend and plan accordingly. It also means to train {*Gharib-ul-Quran*}.

"خَلَقَ" (*khallaq*) and "خَالِقٌ" (*khaaliq*) are two great traits of Allah (59:25, 36:81). Therefore, the individual or nation that has Allah's gift will display great creativity as well.

Having children is not creation, but pro-creation. This is a biological function which animals share with man, Thus, birth is an animal level function. Thus, man's creativity cannot be shared by animals. The nation which is bereft of creativity is devoid of Allah's quality of Creativeness.

Note that creation is not mere duplication, but demands new inventions, Thus, it is said about Allah:

38:1	He keeps adding to His creations according to his Will	يَزِيدُ فِي الْخَلْقِ مَا يَشَاءُ
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Therefore, his slaves must also keep inventing newer things. This is called invention.

About the Messenger **Muhammed** (pbuh), the Quran says:

68:4	and verily you contain very great morals	وَإِنَّكَ لَعَلَى خُلُقٍ عَظِيمٍ
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As said earlier, "خُلُقٌ" (*khalaq*) means balanced and proportionate. Morals are the distinguishing trait of humanity, and our Messenger **Muhammad** was supreme in this. Those traits which are described as "morals" with us are actually the remnants of the era of hegemony. The morals as described by the Quran, which belong to a *momin*, are the true morals, and the Messenger (pbuh) is the epitome of those morals, which is the best example for the human race. This example of the Messenger is preserved in the Quran.

- “الْخَلُّ” (*al-khal*): the path that goes into desert or the path that passes between two deserts.
 “الْخَلَلُ” (*al-khalal*): the space between two things.
 “خِلَالٌ” (*khilaal*): the space between.
 “خِلَالُ الدِّيارِ” (*khilalud dyar*): the space between two houses, the space in the environment of houses.
 “تَخَلَّلَ الشَّيْءُ” (*takhalash-shaiyi*): to go inside a thing, to enter.
 “خَلَّ الشَّيْءُ” (*khallash shaiyi*): drilled a hole into a thing and went through it.
 “أَخْلَلَنَ” (*al-khilaal*): a drill which drills through a thing.
 “أَخْلَلَهُ” (*al-khallah*): need, troubled condition {T}.
 “فَجَاسُوا خِلَالَ الدِّيارِ” (*fajasu khilalid dyaar*): 17:5 they entered the cities: penetrated them:
 “خِلَالِهَا” (*khilalaha*): inside it.
 “خُلَّةٌ” (*khullah*): friendship (2:254), perhaps because friends enter each other's hearts, or need each other.
 “أَحْلَاءُ” (*ikhla'a*) is the plural of “خَلِيلٌ” (*khaleel*) which means friend. (4:164, 43:67).
 “خِلَالٌ” (*khilaal*): mutual friendship.
 “الْخَلُّ” (*al-khal*): vinegar.

- “خَلَا الْمَكَانُ” (*khala-ul makaan*): a house vacated as the occupants go away.
 “خَلَا الشَّيْءُ” (*khala-ush shaiyi*): for something to pass away or go away.
 “خُلُوةٌ” (*khalwah*): means solitude.
 “خَلِيَّةٌ” (*khaliyah*): bees-hive {T}.

Raghib says that “خُلُوٌ” (*khulu*) is used for both place and time. Since time also passes, the scholars of dictionaries take “خَلَا الزَّمَانُ” (*khala-uz zaman*) to mean the time passed {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for one thing to part from another.

The Quran has used “خُلُوٌ” (*khalau*) against “لَقُوا” (*laqu*) in 2:76 and 2:14. Here it means solitude and to meet in solitary.

- “خَلَاؤُا مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ” (*khalau min qablikum*): the people who have passed away prior to you (2:214).
 “تِلْكَ أُمَّةٌ قَدْ خَلَتْ” (*tilka ummatun qad khalat*): this was a group or party who had passed away (2:141).
 “فِي الْأَيَّامِ الْخَالِيَةِ” (*fi al-ayyami khaliyah*): in the days that which have passed away, or past days (69:24).

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:9	you will have full attention of your father; no one else will share it	يَخْلُ لَكُمْ وَجْهَ أَبِيكُمْ
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- “خَلَا فِيهَا نَذِيرٌ” (*khala feeha nazeer*) as in 35:24, means “where no one to warn has been”.
 “تَخَلَّلَتْ” (*takhallat*) as in 84:4, means to be empty and be pure.
 “فَخَلَّوْا سَبِيلَهُمْ” (*fakhallu sabeelahum*) in 9:5 means leave their path, do not argue with them.
 “خَلَّاسِيبِلِ الْأَسِيرِ” (*khalla sabeelal aseer*): means freed the prisoner {R}.

“خَمَدَتِ النَّارُ” (*khamadatin naar*): for the flames of the fire to go out even if the ambers are still glowing. If even the ambers are extinguished, then it will be “هَمَدَتِ النَّارُ” (*hamadatin naar*) {R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for movement to die down and to fall down.

“أَخْمَدْتُهَا” (*akhmad-toha*): I silenced the flames.

“الْخَمُودُ” (*al-khamud*): the place where a fire is buried.

“خَمَدَ الْمَرِيضُ” (*khamadal mareez*): the patient fainted or died.

“قَوْمٌ خَامِدُونَ” (*qaumun khaamedoon*): people whose steps are too silent {M}, or people with no movement.

“أَخَمَدَ اللَّهُ أَنْفَاسَهُ” (*akhmadullahu anfaasuhu*): Allah demeaned him or gave him death {T}.

Surah *Ambia* and *Yaseen* say:

21:15	we made them devoid of the movement of development and made them unmoving like a cut crop	جَعَلْنَاهُمْ خَصِيْدًا خَامِدِيْنَ
36:26	so see, they became silent like the ambers	فَادَاهُمْ خَامِدُوْنَ

Zajaj says it means silent and dead. The nations that are destroyed lose any movement and they turn to ashes. Also the green fields of their life in this world are cut and only their traces remain.

“خَمَرٌ” (*khamr*): to cover or hide something.

“خَمَرَ السَّيِّءُ بِخَمْرٍ” (*khamarash shaiyia yakhmir*): hid him, covered him.

“خَمَرَ فَلَانٌ أَشْهَادَهُ” (*khamara falanun shahadah*): he hid the evidence.

“الْخَمَرُ” (*al-khamar*): veil, a cloth with which women cover their heads {T}. Plural is “خُمُرٌ” (*khumur*) (24:31).

Lataif-ul-Lugha says that initially women used to put on “الْغِفَارَةُ” (*al-ghifaarah*) on their heads, and “الْخِمَارُ” (*al-khimar*) over it. See heading (*Gh-F-R*) the meaning of *ghifaarah*.

“الْخَمَرُ” (*al-khamr*): every intoxicating substance, because it covers the intellect.

Caliph *Umar* has said “الْخَمَرُ مَا خَامَرَ الْعَقْلَ” (*al-khamro ma khamaral aql*). It means that *khamar* is something which interferes with the intellect and spoils it. Some say “لَانَّهَا تَخْمِرُ الْعَقْلَ” (*lannaha takhmirul aql*): that is, liquor has been called “خَمَرٌ” (*khamr*) because it covers the intellect {T}.

The Arabs usually used to make wine from grapes and called it “خَمَرٌ” (*khamr*). Hence, grapes too were called “خَمَرٌ” (*khamr*).

“تَخْمِيرٌ” (*takhmeer*) means to raise the yeast {T}.

“خَامَرَ الرَّجُلُ فِي الْبَيْعِ مُخَامَرَةً” (*khamarar rajulun fee bai-i mukhaamarah*): he deceived in trade and sold a free man as a slave.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to cover and with it to intermingle.

“الْإِسْتِخْمَارُ” (*istikhmaar*) means to enslave, as it is necessary to seize a man's intelligence to enslave him.

About “خَمَرٌ” (*khamr*) and “مَيْسِرٌ” (*maysar*), that is, drinking and gambling, the Quran says:

2:164	it has a lot of sin, and some benefits for people too	فِيهِمَا إِثْمٌ كَبِيرٌ وَ مَنَافِعٌ لِلنَّاسِ
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2:219	their sin is much greater than the benefits in them	وَإِنَّهُمَا أَكْبَرُ مِنْ نَفْعِهِمَا
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“إِسْمٌ” (*ism*) means frustration, tiredness, laziness, such weakness that leaves a man behind in life’s race. See heading (*A-Tha-M*). Wine and gambling (easily acquired wealth) surely get the adrenalin flowing. A man temporarily becomes excited by them, but later his limbs become so exhausted or lackadaisical that they lose the ability to struggle in life. That is why they have been termed “رَجْسٌ مِنْ عَمَلِ الشَّيْطَانِ” (*rijsun min amalish shaitaan*): the devil’s work, by the Quran and warned to abstain from them (5:90). And said that they will create acrimony among you and you will become unable to establish the system of *salaah* (5:91).

“خَمْرٌ” (*khamr*): alcoholic drink. The biological research about it is that initially it increases the blood pressure and this in certain conditions (diseases) is a good thing, but later its effect slows down the blood pressure and this is a deep effect. Therefore, as against the initial benefit its later effect is very harmful. “خَمْرٌ” (*khamr*), as well as “مَيْسِرٌ” (*maysir*) not only slacken the human body, they slacken the human personality as well, and this is a big loss.

Kh-M-S خ م س

“الْخَمْسَةُ” (*al-khamsah*): five.
“يَوْمُ الْخَمِيسِ” (*yaumul khamees*): fifth day.
“خَمْسُونَ” (*khamsoon*): fifty
“خُمْسٌ” (*khumsun*) and “خَمْسٌ” (*khamsun*): fifth part
“خَامِسَةٌ” (*khaamsun*): fifth. Feminine form is “الْخَامِيسَةُ” (*al-khamisah*) as in 24:7.

18:23	And they say they were five	وَيَقُولُونَ خَمْسَةٌ
29:14	Except for fifty years	إِلَّا خَمْسِينَ عَامًا
8:41	Then for Allah, one fifth of it...	فَإِنَّ لِلَّهِ خُمُسَهُ

The fifth part of the war booty is for Allah and His *Rusool* (8:41), *Rusool* being the central administration of Allah’s system. The *ameer*, or leader of the nation will spend it to meet the needs of the nation, and it is called “فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ” (*fee sabilil Allah*).

Kh-M-Sd خ م ص

“الْخَمَصَةُ” (*al-khamsah*): hunger.
“خَمِصَ الْبَطْنُ” (*khamisal batn*): the stomach became empty and caved in.
“الْأَخْمَصُ” (*al-khamas*): the sole of the foot whose curve is inside (concave).
“خَمِيسٌ” (*khamees*): a hungry man whose stomach curves inside.
“زَمَنٌ خَمِيسٌ” (*zamun khamees*) means the period of drought {T}.
The Quran has used “مَخْمَصَةٌ” (*makhmasah*) for acute hunger (5:3).

Kh-M-Te خ م ط

“خَمَطَ اللَّحْمَ يَخْمِطُهُ” (*khamatal lahma yakhmitohu*): he fried the meat. If it is boiled in water then it will be called “مَمْطٌ” (*mamt*).

“الْخَمْطُ” (*al-khamt*): sour, anything bitter, every plant which is bitter, a kind of deadly poison or lethal tree, every tree without needles {T}.

In the Quran, it has been said in connection with punishment that in place of the fine orchards, such orchards grew which were “ذَوَاتِي أَكْلٍ خَمْطٍ” (*zu wa aati ukulin khamt*), that is, which produced bitter fruit. It also means that the pleasantness of their lives was replaced with bitterness.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be naked and empty, and also power and authority. With these meanings the verse would mean to deprive somebody of life for evil deeds or oppression, which is exactly what, happened to the nation of *Sabaa*.

Kh-N-Z-R خ ن ز ر

“الْخَنْزَرَةُ” (*al-khanzarah*): to become fat, big. This word is used for a fat hammer, used to break stones.

“الْخِنْزِيرُ” (*al-khinzeer*): pig, plural of which is “خَنَازِيرُ” (*khanazeer*).

“خَنَزَرَ” (*khanzar*): he committed several acts like a pig. This is also used for seeing out of the corner of the eye {T}.

The Quran has listed meat of pig among the things which are unlawful and hence, forbidden (2:173). The word has also been used for people whose characters have been mutilated and turned like the worst of animal behavior (5:60).

Raghib says it can be used both for mutilated faces and characters. See heading (Q-R-D).

The *Gharib-ul-Quran* says that it is a compound of the words “خَنَزَرَ” (*khaniz*) plus “نَزَرَ” (*nazr*), which means a rotten thing.

The word swine or being a swine is generally considered to be a negative quality in most parts of the world. Even in the west, where its meat is consumed, its name is used as a curse word. The *Bible* too uses this word in a demeaning manner.

Kh-N-S خ ن س

“خَنَسَ عَنْهُ” (*khanasa unhu*), “يَخْنِسُ” (*yakhnis*), “خَنَسَاءُ” (*khanasa*): to get back from it.

“خَنَسَهُ” (*khanasah*): to move someone back.

“الْخُنُسُ” (*al-khunus*): the place where deer hide. Also see “كُنُسٌ” (*kunus*).

“خَنَسَ مِنْ بَيْنِ أَصْحَابِهِ” (*khanasa min baini asaabe-hi*): he hid from among his friends.

“الْخَنَسُ فِي الْقَدَمِ” (*al-khanasu fil qadam*): for the sole of the foot to be even and have flesh {T, R}

“الْخَنِيسُ” (*al-khinees*): a scoundrel who lies in wait for somebody, also one who makes excuses and is a deceptive person {T, R}.

The Quran says “فَلَا أُقْسِمُ بِالْخُنُوسِ” (*fala uksimo bil khunnas*) in 18:15, which means “those stars which recede”, and since stars do not make any sound while doing so, the word has come to mean “to back down silently”. This is the same sort of evidence which has been described in “وَالنَّجْمِ إِذَا هَوَىٰ” (*wan najmi iza hawa*) in 53:1 and 56:75, and this because later the description is about revelation and prophet hood (81:20-22).

Surah *an-Naas* says:

114:4	he who whispers something in the ear and silently recedes (he who quietly spreads wrong thoughts and hides)	الْوَسْوَاسِ الْخَنَّاسِ
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Maulana Abeerullah Sindhi writes that “الْخَنَّاسُ” (*al-khannas*) means a force which hides, or one which when attacked hides.
Ibn Faris says it basically means to hide and to be hidden.

Kh-N-Q خ ن ق

Ibn Faris says it basically means constriction.

“خَنَقَ” (*khanaq*), “يَخْنُقُ” (*yakhneq*): to strangle.
 “الْخَانِيقُ” (*al-khaaniq*) means a narrow valley.
 “الْخَنِيقُ” (*al-khaniq*): means to strangle.
 “الْجَنَاقُ” (*al-khinaaq*): the rope with which one strangles.
 “اِنْخَنَقَ” (*inkhanaq*): his throat was strangled {*T, R*} {*Tafseerul Muqaam al Mahmud* page 221}.
 “خُنَاقٌ” (*khunaaq*) is another derivation.
 “الْمُنْخَنَقَةُ” (*al-munkhaniqah*): the strangled animal. Animal that dies of strangulation has been made forbidden to eat by the Quran (5:3).

Kh-W-R خ و ر

“خَوَّرَ” (*khawir*), “يَخْوَرُ” (*yakhwar*), “خَوْرًا” (*khawara*) means to be weak, to be a coward, to break down, to become slack.
 “خَارَتْ قُوَّةُ الْمَرِيضِ” (*kharat quwwatil mareez*): the patient’s strength lessened, that is, he became weak.
 “خَوَّرَتِ الْأَرْضُ” (*khawwaratil ard*): due to the excessive rains the soil flowed out (with water) {*T, M*}.
 “الْخَوَارُ” (*al-khuwaar*): cow, ox, or goat. It also means the sound of a deer or arrows. Actually it meant the sound of a cow or ox, but later began to be used for all kinds of sounds {*T, M*}.

Raghib says “خُوَارٌ” (*khuwaar*) means the sound of cows or oxen, but later it metaphorically also started to mean the sound of a camel. The Quran has used “لَهُ خُوَارٌ” (*lahu khuwaar*) for “عِجْلٌ” (*ijlun*) or calf in 7:148, that is, the calf that used to make sound.

Kh-W-Zd خ و ض

“خَاضَ” (*khaz*) and “يَخْضُضُ” (*yakhuz*) basically mean to get down in water, or wade in water.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to indulge. Later this word began to be used for being busy in something for long.

The Quran has used it mostly for engaging in useless things {*T, R*}.

“خَاضَ” (*khaaza*): he talked nonsense: {*Aqrabul Muwaarid*}.

The Quran says:

9:69	And you indulge like the one who indulges (engage in useless talk)	وَ خُضْتُمْ كَالَّذِي خَاضُوا
52:12	Those who are engaged in falsehood and are oblivious of the truth	الَّذِينَ هُمْ فِي خَوْضٍ يَلْعَبُونَ
74:45	And we used to indulge in vain talk with those who talked in vain	كُنَّا نَخُوضُ مَعَ الْخَائِضِينَ

This is about the type of leaders who did nothing for the common good, but only repeated statements to this effect, passed resolutions, and spent their time in planning. That is all talk and no work. It also applies to those scholars and philosophers who keep themselves busy in picking loopholes in conceptual issues and nit picking, and ignore the matters which produce practical results. These people cause destruction of their nations (70:41-42).

Kh-W-F خ و ف

“خَوْفٌ” (*khauf*) means to fear some catastrophe due to some evidence and signs of it. Hence, it means to apprehend, just as “طَمَعٌ” (*tama-a*) means to expect some benefit from the evidence and sign before one. The Quran has used them together in 7:56.

“حُزْنٌ” (*huzn*) is the sadness that comes after an event and the loss has already been established. “خَوْفٌ” (*khauf*) is the apprehension of the loss that may take place in the future, while “حُزْنٌ” (*huzn*) is the loss which has already taken place.

Surah *An-Nisaa* says:

4:128	If a woman fears unfair treatment from her husband	وَإِنْ امْرَأَةٌ خَافَتْ مِنْ بَعْلِهَا نُشُورًا
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Thus, the fear of Allah would mean the realization that by leaving Allah’s laws (their obedience) I will suffer a great loss. Hence, it means to avoid the wrong path due to the realization of the bad results it will produce.

Surah *An-Nahal* says about the things in the universe and about the *malaika*:

16:50	They fear the authority and overwhelming of their Sustainer and do whatever they are ordered to do	يَخَافُونَ رَبَّهُمْ مِنْ فَوْقِهِمْ وَيَفْعَلُونَ مَا يُؤْمَرُونَ
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That is, they fully follow the laws of Allah because they know that if they don’t, then only chaos will result. As such, the fear of Allah is not like the fear of some tyrant. This fear is like the apprehension of being burnt due to which we do not play with fire.

“الْخَافَةُ” (*al-khaafah*) is the protective leather that a honey collector puts on, so that he may be protected from the bee stings. It also means a bag which is used for keeping something safe {T}.

“خَوَافٌ” (*khawaaf*): means high level of noise {T}.

Ibn Faris says the root basically means worry and trouble.

“خَوْفٌ” (*khauf*) also means annihilation and war {T}. As such, “خَوْفٌ” (*khauf*) in 33:19 has been taken to mean killing.

“تَخَوَّفَ الشَّيْءَ” (*takhawwafash shjaiyi*): means to decrease something.

“تَخَوَّفَهُ حَقَّهُ” (*takhawwafah haqqah*): reduced his rights.

“أَوْ يَأْخُذْ بِمْ عَلَى تَخَوَّفٍ” (*aw yakhuz hoom ala takhawwuf*): destroy them gradually, instead of at once (16:47).

“تَخَوَّفَ” (*takhawwuf*) means to fear, to be apprehensive all the time, lest they are hauled up despite their fearing Him and being wary of the consequences. But the earlier meaning seems more plausible.

“الْخِيفَةُ” (*al-khafeefah*): the state of fear {M}.

Following the guidance definitely results in a fearless nation without any worries (2:38). Thus, if a nation lives in some kind of fear, then that nation is not following Allah’s orders. To follow Allah’s laws and feel fear, do not go together.

Kh-W-L خ و ل

“الْخَالُ” (*al-khaal*): mother’s brother, maternal uncle.
 Plurals are “أَخْوَالُ” (*akhwaal*), “أَخْوَلَةٌ” (*akhwilah*), “خُؤُولُ” (*khu’ool*).
 “الْخَالَةُ” (*al-khaalah*): mother’s sister, maternal aunt. Plurals are “خَالَاتُ” (*khaalaat*) as in 4:23, “أَخْوَالُ” (*akhwaal*) as in 24:61.
 “الْخَالُ” (*al-khaal*): the sign of goodness in a man, or an army’s flag, or a black camel.
 “هُوَ خَالٌ مَالٍ” (*huwa khalun maal*): he is the guard of the camels {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to look after or guard something.

“خَوْلٌ” (*khawwal*), “تَخْوِيلٌ” (*takhweel*): to endow someone with grandeur or such things which need to be guarded {R}.

“إِذَا خَوْلَهُ نِعْمَةٌ” (*iza khawwalahu ne’mah*) as in 39:8 means “when Allah endows someone with luxuries”.

Kh-W-N خ و ن

“الْخَوْنُ” (*al-khaun*) basically means to decrease something.
 “خَوْنَةٌ” (*khawwanah*): decreased it.
 “فِي ظَهْرِهِ خَوْنٌ” (*fi zahrihi khaun*): his back is weak, or there is weakness in his back.
 “خَوْنٌ” (*khaun*) is also used for glare {T}.

“خَانَ” (*khaan*), “يَخُونُ” (*yakhun*), “خَوْنًا” (*khauna*) is a man who is thought to be trust worthy, but turn out to not be worthy of trust.
 “خِيَانَةٌ” (*khiyaanah*) is to betray or to lose someone’s trust.
 “خَانَ الدَّلْوُ الرَّشَاءُ” (*khaanad dalur risha’a*): the rope was not faithful to the bucket and broke in the middle, due to which the bucket fell into the well {T}. We pull the bucket out of the well by depending on the strength of the rope. If the rope breaks in the middle, then it is called its “خِيَانَةٌ” (*khiyanah*). As such, “أَمَانَةٌ” (*amanah*) means to be at peace with someone or something (to be content that the trust is not lost), but in “خِيَانَةٌ” (*khiyanah*) this trust is simply not there.

This is the reason why Quran says “لَا انفِصَامَ لَهَا” (*la infisaama laha*) in 2:256 describing the laws of Allah’s. These words mean that these laws are a strong link which can never break, and can be fully depended upon. These never leave you in the lurch.

“تَخَوَّنَ” (*takhawwan*) does not just mean to hurt or incur loss, but it also means any change, alteration, decrease, or amendment.
 “خَانَهُ الدَّيْرُ” (*khaanahud dehar*): time was not on his side. That is, it treated him badly {T}.

The Quran says:

22:38	Indeed, Allah does not befriend any of those who betray in denial.	إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُجِبُّ كُلَّ خَوَّانٍ كَفُورٍ
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“خَوَّانٌ” (*khawwan*) can be used for any man who cannot be trusted or depended upon, and also the enemy who tries to deteriorate your condition. It also means a big misappropriate. The Quran instructs to stop even from misappropriation of sight (20:19).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:187	That you used to deceive yourself.	أَنْتُمْ كُنْتُمْ مَخْتَلِينَ أَنْفُسَكُمْ
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Raghib says that “اِخْتِيَانٌ” (*ikhtiyaan*) means to prepare or intend to misappropriate. As such, one must not only try to not misappropriate others, but also oneself. One should not even let the thought of misappropriation cross one’s mind. The biggest crime is to misappropriate from self. That is, to act against what you think is the right thing to do, whether it is in someone’s knowledge or not. This is not only a sign of weakness of one’s self-respect, but also a sign of a dual personality. The Quran forbids it.

Surah *An-Nisaa* says:

4:107	those who intend to deceive each other	الَّذِينَ يَخْتَانُونَ أَنْفُسَهُمْ
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Surah *Al-Anfaal* says: do not conspire against Allah's system "لَا تَخُونُوا" (*la takhunu*), nor be found lacking (misappropriate) in any of the matters entrusted to you.

Kh-W-Y خ و ی

"خَوَاتِ الدَّارِ" (*khawatid daar*): the house became abandoned and fell down.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be vacant and fall.

"أَرْضٌ خَاوِيَةٌ" (*ardun khawiah*): abandoned land {T}.

"الْخَوَاءُ" (*al-khawa*): means to be empty {R}.

"خَوَى الْمَكَانَ" (*khawi al-makaan*): the place became empty {M}.

About a dwelling, surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:256	And it overturned on its roofs	وَهِيَ خَاوِيَةٌ عَلَى عُرُوشِهَا
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This verse is talking about the destroyed and desolated houses which had fallen down, or the houses that despite the roofs standing, were laid bare.

Surah *Al-Haagga* says:

69:7	destroyed date palms which are ready to fall (hollow inside)	أَعْجَازٌ نَخْلٍ خَاوِيَةٍ
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“خَابَ” (*khaab*), “يَخِيبُ” (*yakheeb*), “خَيْبَةً” (*khaibah*) means to remain deprived, to suffer loss, to be disappointed, not to be able to achieve that which is desired, to remain unrequited, expectations to be cut off, to be needy and beggarly. {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says that “الْخَيَابُ” (*al-khayyab*) is a firestone which does not have the capability to start a fire.

The Quran says:

3:126	let them return unrequited	فَيَنْقَلِبُوا خَائِبِينَ
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The Quran has used the word “خَابَ” (*khaab*) against “أَفْلَحَ” (*aflaha*) which means the crops to grow and be fruitful. As such, “خَابَ” (*khaab*) would mean to be unfruitful.

91:10	He who buries it, fails	خَابَ مَنْ دَسَّهَا
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It means that he who pressured it and did not let it develop, his plate remained, desolated. His spark of life became desolate, and became such a fire stone that has no fire. This is why “خَابَ” (*khaab*) has been explained further by saying “هَلَكَ” (*halak*) in surah *Ibrahim*, which means destruction (14:13-15).

It also includes destruction in this life (rather, it is manifested first). Therefore, the nurturing or development of self-results inevitably in the happiness of this life as well. Spiritual development by giving up this world is against the Quran. Human development takes place by conquering the universe. A life without a spark is like a heap of ashes.

“الْخَيْرُ” (*al-khair*): anything which is favored or liked by all, also useful thing. It is the opposite of “الشَّرُّ” (*shar*).

“الْخَيْرُ” (*al-khair*): all types of good. Arab horses used to be called “خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) due to their usefulness (38:32).

“خَيْرَاتٌ” (*khairaat*): beautiful and courteous women {T}, or one who have many good traits as beauty.

“خَيَارٌ” (*khayaar*) means authority, that is, the choice to adopt whichever deed, and leave whichever.

Ibn Faris says it basically means leaning and bending.

“أَنْتَ بِالْخَيَارِ” (*anta bil khayaar*): you have the choice to work according to your wishes.

“خَيْرَهُ بَيْنَ السَّيِّئِينَ” (*khaiyyarahu bainash shaiy-een*): he gave him the right to choose whichever of the two things {T}.

“إِسْتِخَارَةٌ” (*istikharah*) means to ask for the better of two things. Since whichever of two things is in any case thought to be better of the two, “(khairun)” is also used for honor, superiority and estimation.

“هُوَ خَيْرٌ مِنْكَ” (*huwa khairun mink*): he is better than you.

“خَارَ الرَّجُلُ عَلَى غَيْرِهِ وَخَيْرَهُ تَخْيِيرًا” (*khaarar rajula ala ghairihi wa khaiyyarahu takhyeera*): he preferred that individual man over others.

“اخْتَرْتُهُ عَلَيْهِمْ” (*akhtartuhu alaihim*): I gave him superiority, chose him, and selected him over all others.

“الْخِيَارُ” (*al-khiyar*) is a vegetable of a kind (celery).

The Quran has used “خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) to mean wealth at several places, as in 2:272, 2:180.

“خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) has been used against “أَدْنَى” (*adna*) (2:16).

“خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) is used for something “even better” in 2:106.

Surah *Anaam* (6:17) uses this word against “ضُرٌّ” (*zur*), against “فِتْنَةٌ” (*fitnah*) in surah *Al-Hajj* (22:11) and against “شَرٌّ” (*shar*) in surah *Al-Baqrah* (2:216).

Surah *An-Nahal* has used this word for every good thing and deed (16:76).

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* (3:35) says about Allah that “بِيَدِكَ الْخَيْرُ” (*biyadekal khair*): He has the concept for all sorts of authority and every type of good thing.

Surah *Al-Ahzaab* (33:36) has used “خَيْرَةٌ” (*khiyarah*) for choice and right.

Surah *Taha* uses “يَخْتَارُ” (*yakhtaar*) for the natural selection in the universe.

About *Moosa* it is said in 20:13 “وَإِنَّا اخْتَرْنُكَ” (*wa ana akhtartuka*). I have chosen you (selected you) for a great purpose.

In surah *Saad* (38:27), the word of “أَخْيَارٌ” (*akhyaar*) has been used for the Messengers who were the preferred individuals.

Ibn Faris has said “قَوْمٌ خَيَارٌ” (*qaumun khiyaar*) and “أَخْيَارٌ” (*akhyaar*) mean a nation with many capabilities.

In 55:70 “خَيْرَاتُ حِسَالٍ” (*khairatun hisaan*) has been used to mean women with proportionate limbs and moderate character, or for proportionate and good things. Since all life’s happiness and authority and expanse is availed by following Allah’s orders, Therefore, His revelation has also been called “خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) in 23:105. As such, the life of the *momineen* is such that all life’s happiness is available to them and their authority knows no bounds. This is what “خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) is and which is the definite result of following Allah’s orders. That is why when the opponents ask the *momineen*, tell us what your Sustainer has revealed, they reply “قَالُوا خَيْرٌ” (*qaalu khair*) in 16:30. In this verse these words mean world’s happiness and the expanse of authority.

It is explained by the words that follow:

16:30	pleasantness in this world as well as pleasantness in the Hereafter	فِي هَذِهِ الدُّنْيَا حَسَنَةٌ وَلَدَا الْآخِرَةِ خَيْرٌ
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Thus, every deed which has the betterment of this world and the Hereafter is “خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) and the opposite of “الشَّرُّ” (*shar*). In pleasantness, the development of the human personality is supreme. Rather pleasantness is the development of the human personality. That which stultifies human development is “الشَّرُّ” (*shar*). The Quran gives us a program which results in pleasantness. It equates them with good deeds, which develop human capabilities and produce smoothness in the society. See heading (*Sd-L-H*).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says about *Hajj* (pilgrimage):

2:197	you must take what is necessary to perform Hajj (pilgrimage): this will help prevent you from begging over there	وَتَزَوَّدُوا فَإِنَّ خَيْرَ الزَّادِ التَّقْوَى
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Here “خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) means benefits and “تَقْوَى” (*taqwa*) means to be safe from the ignominy of being needy.

Kh-Y-Te خ ي ط

“الْخَيْطُ” (*al-khait*) means thread or chain etc. {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to be long and thin.

“الْخِيَاةُ” (*al-khiyaat*) or “الْمِخْيَاطُ” (*al-mikhyat*) means a needle {T}.

“فِي سَمِّ الْخِيَاةِ” (*fi sammil khiyaat*): in the needle of the eye (7:40).

“خَاطَ الثُّوبَ” (*khaatas-saub*): to sew one part of the cloth with another {M}.

“خَيَّاطٌ” (*khaiyyaat*): tailor {T}.

The Quran, in respect of fasting says:

2:187	white thread and black thread	الْخَيْطُ الْأَبْيَضُ وَ الْخَيْطُ الْأَسْوَدُ
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These words are relating to the light of dawn and the darkness of the night {T}. This shows that in the Quran, literal meanings do not apply and the meaning is with reference to the context.

As such, *Lataif-ul-Lugha* says that “الْخَيْطُ الْأَبْيَضُ” (*al-khaitul abyaz*) is taken to mean “النُّورُ” (*an-noor*) which means light.
“الْخَيْطُ” (*al-khait*) also means color {T}, and even a group.

Kh-Y-L خ ي ل

“خَالَ” (*khaal*), “يَخَالُ” (*yakhaal*) means to conjecture, assumption.
“خَيَّلَ” (*khyyal*) means to estimate and guess.
“خَيَّلَ إِلَيْهِ أَنَّهُ كَذَا” (*khuyyila ilaihi annahu kaza*): he thought of something, something which is not as it seems but which appears so in one’s thoughts.
“السَّحَابَةُ الْمُخَيَّلَةُ” (*as sahabatu almuta-khayyila*) is a cloud which seems to be raining.
“الْخَيَالُ” (*al-khiyaal*) also means a scarecrow {T}.

With respect to such meanings, when the experts of the Pharaoh’s court threw their ropes:

20:66	due to their charm, it appeared to <i>Moosa</i> (Moses) as if they were moving (like snakes):	يُحَيِّلُ إِلَيْهِ مِنْ سِحْرِهِمْ أَنَّهُ تَسْعَى
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This means that they were not actually moving, but only gave the illusion of movement. Note how big a truth about illusion or “سحر” (*seher*) the Quran has revealed. It has said that due to illusion, the things do not actually change regardless what one’s vision says. The effect is merely psychological.

The confusion only occurs when we take the meanings of such words literally, but if taken figuratively then the meaning would be something else. The details will be found at their own places.
See heading (S-H-R).

“خِيَلًا” (*khuyela*): pride without any cause (unjustifiably). That is, a man gives himself airs, but he does not have the greatness in him. He simply thinks in his mind that he is great. Someone who does this is called “مُخْتَالًا” (*mukhtaal*), as in 31:18, which means one who is indulging in self-deceit.

Ibn Faris says it basically means an act which also includes delusion. This is the definition of “خَيَالًا” (*khayaal*), which is actually something one dreams about. For one thing, everything in a dream is shifting, secondly the dreamers thinks that whatever he is dreaming about, is reality. This makes the meaning of this verse clearer, and elaborates the sorcery of the sorcerers, as well as earlier mentioned verse (20:66).

Raghib says this led to the word “خَيْلًا” (*khail*) which means horses or a cavalry brigade (3:13), because a horse seems to be walking rather proudly, and a horseman also has a sort of pride in him as well.

Kh-Y-M خ ي م

“تَخَيَّمَ” (*takhyeem*) means to mount tents and then rest in them.
“خَيْمَةً” (*khaemah*) means any kind of temporary construction that Arabs used to set up for their rest. There are many definitions regarding the structure of such a construction, but the general concept is of setting

up four wooden pillars covered with vegetation for shelter and shadow. Such a construction was called “خَيْمَةٌ” (*khaemah*). Those tents that were constructed with fabrics were called “مِزَالَّةٌ” (*mizallah*). “خَيْمَ الشَّيْءِ” (*khayyamash shay*) means that he covered on thing with another thing {T}. “خِيَامٌ” (*khayaam*) is the plural form of “خَيْمَةٌ” (*khaemah*), as used in 55:72.

“الدَّابُّ” (*ad-daab*), “الدَّابُّ” (*addaobo*): to be continuously engaged in some work, to keep trying continuously.

Raghib says that it means situation, customs, and traditions.

“دَابُّ فُلَانٍ” (*daaba folan*): that man tried continuously, became tired but kept on trying {*T, M, Aqrab al-Muwarid*}. *Kitaab-ul- Ashfaq* too says that “دَابُّ” (*da-ab*) means work done continuously without any break.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is of being persistent.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:10	according to the ways of the nation of the Pharaoh	كَذَّابٍ آلِ فِرْعَوْنَ
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Surah *Yusuf* has “دَابَّاهُ” (*da-abba*) in verse 12:47 which means striving very hard continuously.

Surah *Ibrahim* says:

14:33	The sun and the moon revolve continuously in their orbits at their own speed. (They are continuously busy in performing their duties.)	وَالشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ دَائِبَيْنِ
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The Quran says that **Dawood** (David) was among the descendants of **Ibrahim** (Abraham).

6:84	And of his descendants was Dawood	وَمِنْ ذُرِّيَّتِهِ دَاوُدَ
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Allah had given him **Zaboor**. Note that **Zaboor** also means ‘a book’. But surah *Ambia* mentions “**Zaboor**” as a special book in 21:105. Perhaps this was the name of the book revealed to him. He was granted knowledge in profusion (27:15) and a stable rule (38:20), so that he could rule with equanimity and justice (38:26). The big leaders of the mountain tribes were very faithful and obedient to him and were busy in putting his program into action (38:18), as well as the gypsies of the **Tair** tribe who formed the cavalry brigade of the army (38:16).

Previously he had defeated the army of **Jaloot** (Goliath) fighting along with the army of **Bani Israel** and killed **Jaloot** as well (2:251). It seems like he was the inventor of armor, or that he had special expertise in it (21:80). His period was approximately 1000 B.C. It is said that he had a very beautiful voice. He is said to be the first person to edit Hebrew music and develop the Egyptian and Babylonian musical instruments, and Thus, invent new musical instruments. When he used to sit on the hill and play his musical instruments, even the trees swayed with the music. The **Torah** and our **Tafseer** books support this theory {*Tarjuman-ul-Quran*}.

“دَبَّ النَّمْلُ يَدِبُّ دَبًّا” (*dabbal namalu yadibbu dabba*): to walk quietly.
 “دَبَّ الشَّرَابُ فِي الْجِسْمِ” (*dabbah fil jism*): for wine to go down slowly in the body.
 “الدَّابَّةُ” (*ad-dabbah*): any living thing that walks or crawls on the ground {*T, Latif-ul-Lugha*}.
 “الدَّبَّةُ” (*adib-bah*): slow speed.

Ibn Faris says that this is the speed slower than “مَشَى” (*mashyun*).

“الدَّبَابَةُ” (*addab-babah*): a big cart made of skins and wood used by soldiers to reach the fort gates to break it down {*T, Latif-ul-Lugha*}. A tank of the olden days used to move slowly and those inside were safe from the enemy’s onslaught.

“الدَّبْدَبَةُ” (*addab-dabah*): the sound of a walk on hard ground, it also means a noise like beating the drum, and also the sound of the drum itself.

The Quran has used this word for all sorts of creatures including crawlers, two legged and four legged (24:45). The plural is “دَوَابُّ” (*dawaab*). In surah *Al-Hajj*, this word has been used for all living creatures except man (35:28)

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:61	If Allah held people responsible for their crimes immediately, then there would not be a <i>da-abba</i> (soul) (alive) on this earth.	لَوْ يُؤَاخِذُ اللَّهُ النَّاسَ بِظُلْمِهِمْ مَا تَرَكَ عَلَيْهَا مِنْ دَابَّةٍ
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See 35:45 as well

Here the word “دَابَّةٌ” (*da-abbah*) has come for the humans themselves, because due to their wrong doings it is they who must be annihilated, not all other living creatures. But in a broader meaning, it could mean humans and other living beings as well.

Surah *Al-Anfaal* calls those who do not employ their intellect “شَرَّ الدَّوَابِّ” (*ash sharrad dwab*) in 8:22, that is, the worst among living things who walk, or even more astray than the other living things.

Surah *An-Namal* says:

27:82	And when the sentence against them is fulfilled, We shall bring forth a creature from the earth for them	وَإِذَا وَقَعَ الْقَوْلُ عَلَيْهِمْ أَخْرَجْنَا لَهُمْ دَابَّةً مِّنَ الْأَرْضِ تُكَلِّمُهُمْ
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Raghib says it refers to those wicked people who behave like animals in their unawareness. This way this word becomes plural. But when the Quran uses the word “دَابَّةٌ” (*da-abbatun*) for humans, the example about animals is redundant. It will mean warring nations. This has been explained by “تُكَلِّمُهُمْ” (*tukallemohim*) which means to injure. But even if “تُكَلِّمُهُمْ” (*tukallemohim*) is taken to mean talk, it does not affect the meaning of “دَابَّةٌ” (*da-abbah*). See heading (K-L-W).

Surah *Saba* has used this word for *Suleman*’s unworthy son (34:14). This means that he did not have the credentials of an intellectual human being, but a moving apparition. Details will be found under heading *Suleman*.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:6	There is not a single <i>da-abbah</i> on this earth for whose sustenance Allah is not responsible for.	وَمَا مِنْ دَابَّةٍ فِي الْأَرْضِ إِلَّا عَلَى اللَّهِ رِزْقُهَا
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A natural question that comes to mind after reading 11:6 is that if this statement is true, then why people die of hunger in this world. A single drought may claim millions of lives and even as it is, thousands die of hunger and starvation. If Allah is responsible for providing for them, then why does He not fulfill that responsibility? This is a very important question that demands an answer.

At such places, Allah's responsibility is fulfilled by the system set in place by following Allah's laws. This system takes upon itself all the responsibilities attributed to Allah and in this way all those rights and duties (mentioned in the Quran) are also shifted to the system which are called Allah's rights. Allah's system is followed by obeying His laws.

“عَلَى اللَّهِ رِزْقُهَا” (*alal lahi rizqoha*) means that the system is responsible for the sustenance of all. To provide for all living things, becomes its responsibility. The resources of sustenance are with it for safekeeping and are a trust. The system so distributes the sustenance given by Allah that nobody is deprived of it. This way Allah's responsibility is automatically fulfilled. But in the absence of such a system, hegemonic forces seize those resources, and the weaker of the human races live at their mercy. They provide as much as they want for the ones they want to provide for. The celestial revolution is for snatching these resources and hand them over to the system which provides for all.

Surah *Ash-Shura* says:

49:29	And one of Allah's signs is that He created the earth and the skies and heavenly bodies and the living things (<i>da- abba</i>) in them. And He is able to collect them according to the law of His will.	وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا مِنْ دَآئِبَةٍ وَهُوَ عَلَىٰ جَمْعِهِمْ إِذْ يَشَاءُ قَدِيرٌ
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This verse gives a clue as to creatures on other heavenly bodies. The days are coming near when one day the inhabitants of earth will intermingle with that of other planets. The Quran has clearly stated that whatever is contained in the earth and the skies has been subjugated to man. Therefore, the human effort to reach the heavenly bodies (moon, mars, etc.) is very much in keeping with the teachings of the Quran. Note how the Quranic verses provide clues to universal truths (41:35).

D-B-R

د ب ر

“الدُّبُرُ” (*ad-dubur*), “الدَّبْرُ” (*ad-dubr*): the back (end) of anything. It is also used for ones back and the anus.

Ibn Faris has said that it means the tail end of something. Plural form of it is “أَدْبَارٌ” (*ad-baar*).

The Quran says:

54:25	they will turn their backs	يُوَلُّونَ الدُّبُرَ
12:25	from behind	مِنْ دُبُرٍ
27:10	he turned his back and ran	وَلَّىٰ مُدْبِرًا

“إِدْبَارٌ” (*idbar*): to move back, previous event.

“إِدْبَارَ النُّجُومِ” (*idbaran nujum*): the time for the stars to set at the end of night (52:49) {*T, M*}. Hence, it means the receding of the stars.

“الدَّابِرُ” (*ad-daabir*): the end of everything, the reality and basis {*T, M*}.

“التَّدْبِيرُ” (*at-tadbeeru*), “التَّدْبِيرُ” (*at-tadibbiru*): to deliberate on some issue with its end result in mind. To keep the last destination in mind while administrating.

6:45	last man of the nation was killed as well (nation was uprooted)	فَقُطِعَ دَابِرُ الْقَوْمِ
32:5	he plans matters	يُدَبِّرُ الْأَمْرَ
4:82	Do they not deliberate on what the Quran says?	أَفَلَا يَتَدَبَّرُونَ الْقُرْآنَ
38:29	so that they deliberate on its (the Quran's) verses	لِيَتَدَبَّرُوا آيَاتِهِ

79:5	One who takes matters to completion (one who plans matters)	الْمُدَبِّرَاتِ أَمْرًا
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Surah **Qaf** says following to the Messenger:

50:39	Do not worry or be troubled by whatever his opponents said. Just continue being engaged in preparing (the people) in worshipping and praising the Lord. Strive from before the sunrise till sunset, as well as during the night, for the completion (establishment) of His system.	فَاصْبِرْ عَلَىٰ مَا يَقُولُونَ وَسَبِّحْ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّكَ قَبْلَ طُلُوعِ الشَّمْسِ وَقَبْلَ الْغُرُوبِ- وَ مِنَ اللَّيْلِ فَسَبِّحْهُ وَ أَدْبَارَ السُّجُودِ
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Surah **At-Toor** repeats almost the same thing in almost the same words but there it is said “أَدْبَارَ النُّجُومِ” (*adbaarin nujoom*), which means the time when stars set or recede.

Surah **Qaaf** has used “أَدْبَارَ” (*adbaar*) which is the plural of “دُبُرَ” (*dubur*). The other word is “سُجُودَ” (*sujud*) which means to lean or bend towards someone. The ordinary exegesis books say that the meaning is “after-prayers”, but this meaning does not make much sense, especially because the word used here is “أَدْبَارَ” (*adbaar*) not “إِدْبَارَ” (*idbaar*). {*Lissan-ul-Arab. Tafseer Fatahul Qadeer (Shokani) - Tafseer Roohul Muani*}.

“دُبُرَ” (*dubur*) also means the end part of something, which is in any case included in that thing, and ‘after’ is used when something ends and then some other event or thing begins. We cannot say up till today with certainty what it really means.

D-Th-R

د ث ر

“الدَّثَرُ” (*ad-dasr*): enormous wealth.
“مَالٌ دَثَرٌ” (*maal dasr*): unbounded riches.
“الدِّثَارُ” (*ad-disaar*): a cloth which a man can wrap around himself.
“تَدَثَّرَ بِالنَّوْبِ” (*tadassara bis saub*): he wrapped himself in a cloth.
“دَثَّرَ الشَّجَرُ دُثُورًا” (*dasarash shajaru dasoora*): the tree brought out new leaves and branches.
“هُوَ دَثَّرَ مَالِي” (*hudasru maal*): he is a good guard of the camels.
“تَدَثَّرَ الطَّائِرُ” (*tadreesut tayir*): a bird mends its nest.
“الدَّثُورُ” (*ad-dasoor*): slow, heavy, one who sleeps a lot, i.e. one who is wrapped in sheets.
“دَثَّرَ الْأَثَرُ” (*dasaral asar*): for a mark to be obliterated {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for things to come one after the other, to be deposited layer upon layer, or to climb over.

Raghib and **Ibn Faris** have stated various meanings for this root, which include overwhelming someone.

“مَنْزِلٌ دَاثِرٌ” (*manzilun daasir*): the destination whose signs have been obliterated, or have been hidden by layer upon layer of dust.

The Quran has addressed the Messenger **Muhammad** as “يَا أَيُّهَا الْمُدَّثِّرُ” (*ya ayyohul mudassir*) in 74:1. Considering the meaning of “الدِّثَارُ” (*ad-disaar*) it is generally translated as. “**O, the one who has wrapped himself in a cloth**”. But according to *tadreesut tayir*, it would mean “**O, one who sets his house in order**”, and as per “دَثَّرَ مَالِي” (*disru maal*), it would mean good caretaker. The meaning is Hence, “**O you who has the responsibility of setting humanity in order**”, or “**O you who has come to solve humanity’s problems with tactfulness and good scheme**”. These meanings seem more appropriate. As per “دَثَّرَ الشَّجَرُ” (*dasarush shajar*) it would mean “**O you whose coming heralds the dawn of a new era**”, or “**O you with whose coming the garden of the world will see a new spring**”

After this address, the Messenger (*pbuh*) was told “قُمْ فَأَنْذِرْ” (*qum fa anzir*) in 74.2. This means “**rise and warn the world of the results of wrong deeds**”. After this, the various elements of this revolutionary invitation have been brought forward. This too, reveals that “الْمُذَيِّرُ” (*al-mudassir*) has the element of the wellbeing of humanity and the revolutionary message. This is what the responsibility and the particularity of a celestial inviter is.

Raghib’s meaning has the element of overwhelming the untrue concepts, but could also mean overpowering.

The Quran says:

9:33	so that super imposes (overwhelms) it on all other religions or ways of life	لِيُظْهِرَهُ عَلَى الدِّينِ كُلِّهِ
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Ibn Faris has given some examples:

“تَدَاثَّرَ الرَّجُلُ فَرَسَهُ” (*tadassara-rajulu farasahu*): the man jumped and got on his horse {*Lisan-ul-Arab*}. Here “jumped up” is very important. This thing (revolution) does not take place gradually. The revolution which took place at the hands of the Messenger (*pbuh*) was also revolutionary. Thereafter the Quranic concepts are now gradually hold in the world. This is the evolutionary system. The world considers one concept, tests it and finds that the concept presented by the Quran was the correct one, and which the Messenger (*pbuh*) successfully implemented. Therefore, now gradually the Quranic concepts are replacing false concepts. But if a group takes up this concept or a government implements these concepts, then this concept can revolutionarily replace other concepts in the world. It is yet to be seen which nation initiates this noble work. That nation will be the biggest benefactor of mankind, and by its hands the universe will blossom and at its hands the flowers of life’s tree will bloom once again.

Tafseer of Rohul Kuani says that “الْمُذَيِّرُ” (*al-mudassir*) means one who is endowed with miracles and messenger-hood. Figuratively, it says that it also means a man who has no program before him and Hence, is free. This would mean that by saying “قُمْ فَأَنْذِرْ” (*qum fa anzar*) the Quran endowed him with a great program.

Tafseer Fatahal Qadeer says it means one who bears the responsibility of messenger-hood and its responsibilities. Some say that “الْمُذَيِّرُ” (*al-mudassir*) initially was “الْمُذَيِّرُ” (*al-mudatassir*), meaning someone from the linguistic group of “تَفَعَّلَ” (*tafa’aul*), and got transformed to its current state over time.

D-H-R

د ح ر

“الذَّحْرُ” (*ad-dahr*) means to get someone out, to oust someone, to remove someone, to push out or to oust insultingly {*T, R, M*}.

The Quran says:

37:8-9	And they are condemned by all sides. (they are the rejected ones of all accounts)	وَيُعَذِّبُونَ مِنْ كُلِّ جَانِبٍ ذُحُورًا
7:18	Ignominious, condemned, the removed one	مَذَّةٌ وَمَا مَذْحُورًا

D-H-Zd

د ح ض

“نَحَضَ” (*dahz*) actually means to slip. Later it came to mean to remove, obliterate or make untrue. “نَحَضَ بِرَجْلِهِ” (*dahaza berijlehi*) is said when somebody thrashes around like a slaughtered animal. “مَكَانٌ نَحْضٌ” (*makanun dahz*) is a slippery place {*T, R, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to move out or to slip.

18:56	So they remove truth from its place through falsehood and make it useless.	لِيُدْحِضُوا بِهِ الْحَقَّ
42:16	Their reasoning and claim is very weak and transitory in the eyes of God.	حُجَّتُهُمْ دَاحِضَةٌ
7:141	He slipped, he lost strength, and he became weak and powerless.	فَكَانَ مِنَ الْمُدْحَضِينَ

“نَحَى” (*daha*) is to spread out, to make vast {T}.

“نَحَا الْمَطَرُ الْحَصَا” (*dahal matarul hasa*): the rain washed out the pebbles.

“نَحَى الْإِبِلَ” (*dahal ibl*): he shooed the camels i.e. he drove them.

“مَرَّ الْفَرَسُ يَذْحُوْ دَحْوًا” (*marralfarasu yadhu dahwa*): the horse ran digging his hooves in the ground {R}.

“يُوَيْدُ حُوْبَالِحَجَرَ” (*huwaid hubilhajar*): he throws stones {Lisan-ul-Arab}.

Taj-ul-Urus says that the phrase which contains this meaning is “يَذْحُو الْحَجَرَ بِيَدِهِ” (*yad hubilhajara biyadehi*).

Keep these meanings of “نَحَا” (*daha*) in mind and consider the Quranic verse in which it is said about the creation of heavenly bodies:

79:30	And threw the earth after it and made it smooth	وَالْأَرْضَ بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ دَحَاهَا
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Surah *Al-Anbia* says:

21:30	The heaven and the earth were previously joined together and then they got separated.	إِنَّ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ كَانَتَا رَتْقًا فَفَتَقْنَاهُمَا
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Thus, the earth became a separate entity. Then with further changes it was made smooth (habitable). This fact has been stated as “نَحَايَا” (*dahaha*). The earth was separated as if it was a stone thrown from a sling, or as the rain washes out the pebbles afar. Note that about a thousand and five hundred years ago, such things were related about the universe only through the Revelation.

“بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ” (*ba'daa zalika*) reveals the fact that the earth was created later than the mass. That is, it came into existence in the second stage. The first stage is the mass when the earth and the sky were joined together. Then the heavenly bodies got separated from the mass and began to revolve in their own orbits (36:40).

“نَخَرُ” (*dakhar*), “يَنْخَرُ” (*yadkharu*), “نَخِرَ” (*dakhir*), “يَنْخِرُ” (*yadkhar*): to be humble (small), to be obedient and bow (before someone).

“الْدَّخِرُ” (*ad-dakhir*): someone who bows.

“دُخُورٌ” (*dukhur*): ignominy and smallness.

“الْدَّخَرُ” (*adakhhar*) means surprise which is actually a manifestation of the helplessness of the intellect (that reason which is unable to explain something).

“أَدْخَرَهُ” (*adkhara*): he insulted him, made him helpless {T, R, M}.

The Quran says about the things in the universe that they are “دَاخِرُونَ” (*daakheroon*) in 16:48. This means that they are subservient to the laws of Allah.

This meaning has been made explicit by the next adjacent verse which says:

16:46	Whatever there is in the highs and lows of the universe, is subservient to Allah.	لِّلَّهِ يَسْجُدُ مَا فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ
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For details, see heading (*S-J-D*).

“دَخَلَ” (*dakhala*), “يَدْخُلُ” (*yadkhulu*): entered, it is the opposite of “خَرَجَ” (*kharaja*), as in 2:111.
 “أَدْخَلَ” (*adkhal*): made him enter (17:80).
 “دَاخِلَةُ الْأَرْضِ” (*daakhilatul ard*): things which are hidden (buried) inside the earth.
 “الدَّخْلُ” (*ad-dakhl*): the income from one’s property.
 “الدَّخْلُ” (*ad-dakhal*): It means deceit, as well as intellectual or physical deterioration, and also chaos {T}.
 It also alleges internal deterioration and enmity, according to *Raghib*.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:92	You make your promises the basis for your mutual chaos.	تَجِدُونَ إِيْمَانَكُمْ دَخَلًا بَيْنَكُمْ
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Here “دَخَلَ” (*dakhal*) means chaos and conflict.

“دَخَلَ بِالْمَرْأَةِ” (*dakhal bil mar’ah*): he had sexual intercourse with a woman.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:23	Out from the wombs of the women with whom you have had sexual intercourse (out of wedlock)	مِنْ نِسَاءِكُم الَّتِي دَخَلْتُمْ بِهِنَّ
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In surah *At-Tauba*, while mentioning the mentality of the hypocrites, it is said that they have come with you to the battlefield unwillingly. Their condition is such that:

9:87	If they would find some place to hide or escape to, or entrance to some hiding place, then they will run towards it madly.	لَوْ يَجِدُونَ مَلْجَأً أَوْ مَغْرَبًا أَوْ مُدْخَلًا لَوَلَّوْا إِلَيْهِ وَهُمْ يَجْمَحُونَ
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Here the Quran has used the word “مُدْخَلًا” (*muddakhala*) which indicates to that if they can find even a small place to hide, then they will try to enter it, no matter how much they have to strive for it.

“الدُّخَانُ” (*ad-dukhaan*): smoke.

“دَخَنَ الْغُبَارُ دُخُونًا” (*dakhanal ghubaaru dukhuna*): the dust rose {T, M, R}.

“دَخَنَ الْفِتْنَةُ” (*dakhanul fitna*): to disclose some *fitnah* (something that would lead to anarchy) something that instigate (people to chaos) {T}.

“خُلِقَ دَاخِنٌ” (*khulqun daakhin*): bad manners.

“الدُّخَانُ” (*ad-dukhaan*) means drought or hunger because a hungry man perceives a sort of cloud between the earth and the sky (the atmosphere is cloudy to him). Some say that hunger is called “دُخَانٌ” (*dukhaan*) because in a drought the dust rises and makes a sort of cloud. It also means anything bad, and deterioration.

“الدُّخَانُ” (*ad-dukhan*) is used for something bad or dysfunctional.

“يَوْمَ دُخْنَانَ” (*yaumun dukhnaan*): a day of intense heat and travails {T}.

The Quran says that the earth was created in two stages:

41:11	Then He turned to the other heavenly bodies which were in a smoky condition (or in gaseous condition).	ثُمَّ اسْتَوَىٰ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ وَهِيَ دُخَانٌ
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Modern science confirms this although the Quran had disclosed it about fifteen hundred years ago. The earliest form of the heavenly bodies is indeed said to be nebulous.

Surah *Ad-Dukhaan* says:

44:10	When the atmosphere is filled with smoke.	يَوْمَ تَأْتِي السَّمَاءُ بِدُخَانٍ مُبِينٍ
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This verse could mean the time when problems and difficulties abound. There will be chaos and anarchy everywhere, or the sky will seem filled with smoke due to hunger or drought. It will be a great punishment (44:11).

D-R-A

د ر ء

“دَرَأَ” (*daraa*), “يَدْرُؤُ” (*badra-oo*), “دَرَأَ” (*draa*): to reject and to remove angrily {*T, M, R*}.
 “دَرَأَ عَلَيْهِمْ دُرُوءًا” (*dara’a alaihim durwa*): to appear before someone suddenly.
 “جَاءَ الشَّيْلُ دَرَأًا” (*ja’ashaylo dar’a*): the flood appeared from nowhere {*T*}.
 “دَرَأْتُهُ عَنِّي” (*daratohu anni*): I removed him from my side (3:167).
 “مُدَارَاةٌ” (*mudaarah*): means opposition and defiance {*T*}.

The Quran says:

24:8	this can remove (save) the woman from punishment	وَيَذَرُوهَا الْعَذَابَ
28:54	Get rid of <i>sayyeaat</i> (sins, or bad things) with good things (Behavior etc.)	وَيَذَرُهُمْ وَنَ بِالْحُسْنَى السَّيِّئَةِ

This is a great reality which the Quran has mentioned at different places in different styles. It says a bad thing in return for a bad thing is not the answer. If you are weak, then germs will attack you and sicken you. The cure is to increase your defiance. This way your deterioration will be checked and your constructive process will continue. In every aspect of life, this is the right way of defense. This is called the scales of goodness to tip.

“تَدَاؤًا وَفِي الْخُصُومَةِ” (*tada aoo fil khusumah*) means to push and shove each other, or to blame each other and Thus, have differences {*T*}. In these meanings this word has been used in 2:72 “فَادْرَأْهُمْ فِيهَا” (*fa ad-dara’otum fiha*). Scholars of dictionaries say that this was in reality “تَدَارَأْتُمْ” (*tadaaratum*).

D-R-J

د ر ج

“دَرَجَ” (*daraj*): to walk very slowly, to crawl {*T*}. It means to walk like a mountaineer i.e. like climbing a mountain {*R*}.
 “مَدْرَجَةُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*madrajatut tareeq*): the distinct and open part of the road.
 “دَرَجَ الْقَوْمُ” (*daraj al-qaum*): the nation dwindled gradually, and became extinct.

The Quran says:

7:182	We will catch them slowly (gradually) and they will not even know where the destruction came from	سَنَسْخَرُهُمْ مِنْ حَيْثُ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ
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“دَرَجَ الشَّيْءُ” (*darajash shai yi*): he folded the thing and wrapped it.
 “الدَّرَجُ” (*ad-darf*): something on which there is some writing.
 “دَرَجُ الْكِتَابِ” (*darjul kitaab*): a fold of the book {*T*}.
 “الدَّرَجَةُ” (*ad-darajah*): one of the steps of a ladder (the steps which take one upwards)
 “دَرَجَاتُ” (*darajaat*): the steps which will bring you downwards are “دَرَكَاتُ” (*darakaat*) {*L*}.
 “الْمَدَارِجُ” (*al-madaarij*): the mountain roads which generally get higher with every turn {*T*}.

Raghib says “دَرَجَةٌ” (*darajah*) and “مَنْزِلَةٌ” (*manzilah*) are almost the same, but *manzilah*, which is a place to get down to, is called *darajah* when it is being used to climb upwards. *Darajah* is also taken to mean value and estimation and Thus, means honors, or stages over one another.

The Quran says regarding those who engage themselves in *jihad* that their status, or “دَرَجَةٌ” (*darajah*) is over “قَاعِدِينَ” (*qa’ideen*) or those who remain seated behind (4:95).

Surah *At-Tauba* says the following regarding those who do *jihad* and those who migrate for this cause:

9:20	Those who are peace seekers have migrated and done <i>jihad</i> in the way of Allah with their wealth and lives, hold a high status with Allah	الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَهَاجَرُوا وَجَاهَدُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ بِأَمْوَالِهِمْ وَأَنْفُسِهِمْ أَكْثَرُ دَرَجَةً عِنْدَ اللَّهِ
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The Quran says about men and women:

2:228	women, according to good practices, have rights according (apropos) their responsibilities	وَلَهُنَّ مِثْلُ الَّذِي عَلَيْهِنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ
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That is, just as men have rights over women, women too have rights over men. As per the responsibilities and rights, no one has superiority over the other. Both are equal in this respect. But after this, it is said:

2:228	men have superiority over women in one thing	وَاللِّرِّجَالِ عَلَيْهِنَّ دَرَجَةٌ
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What is that one thing? The next verse says that a divorced woman will have to observe “عِدَّتْ” (*iddat*) or celibacy for a period during which she cannot wed another man, but men do not have to observe this period. Also if the man has divorced the woman and repents it, then he can bring the woman back into his wedlock during this period.

2:228	And their husbands would do better to take them back in that case if they desire reconciliation.	وَيُعَوِّلُهُنَّ أَحَقُّ بِرَدِّهِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ إِنْ أَرَادُوا إِصْلَاحًا
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Now consider human history. Everywhere you will find “عَلَيْهِنَّ” (*al-aihinna*) i.e. only rights for men and responsibilities for women! No right of women will be accepted as a right and a woman cannot demand any of her rights as a matter of right. This revolutionary voice that women have rights as well came only from the Quran, so many years ago. These few words (of the verse) have brought a revolutionary change in man’s social or civilized life. Look how composite these words are which don’t leave matters at the will of any individual or society. It has been made a provision in the laws of Allah (that women have rights too). The Quran also tells you what the matter is in which men are superior.

But this does not mean that equality in rights is equality in responsibilities. According to their functions, Nature has differentiated between them. They have been created differently (according to their biology) and a woman is supposed to fulfill the responsibilities she is required to fulfill while men according to theirs. The woman’s responsibility which man cannot fulfill is to give birth and bring up the children. Since this takes up most of the woman’s time, earning has been made man’s responsibility (2:34).

D-R-R

د ر ر

“الْدَّر” (*ad-dar*): milk (but it has the connotation of a thick stream and abundance).

“الْدَّرَةُ” (*aliddarraah*): profusion of milk.

“إِسْتَدَرَّ اللَّابَنُ” (*istadar ral laban*): the milk became abundant.

“دَرَّتِ السَّمَاءُ بِالْمَطَرِ” (*darratis sama-o bil matar*): it rained heavily from the skies.

“مِدْرَارٌ” (*midrar*): clouds which cause heavy rain (6:6).

“دَرَّ السَّرَاجُ” (*darras siraj*): the lamp became well lighted (bright).

“كَوْكَبٌ دُرِّيٌّ” (*kaukabun durriyyun*): shiny, bright star {*T, R*} which sends forth rays of light (22:35), or like a pearl.

Muheet says that “الْدَّرُ” (*ad-daar*) means for one thing to be born from another, like milk from animals, brightness from the stars, etc. *Ibn Faris* agrees with this meaning as well.

It also means movement and unease. Allah has termed the light of His guidance (the noble Quran) as “كَوْكَبٌ دُرِّيٌّ” (*kaukabun durriyyun*), like a star which sends forth the light of knowledge and insight, and which is not stagnant but with continuous movement. This light is born of God’s Divine knowledge and spreads to all corners of the earth.

D-R-S

درس

“دَرَسَ الشَّيْءُ” (*daras shaiyi*) means something became old and was obliterated {M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to hide, to be low and be obliterated.

“دَرَسَهُ الْقَوْمُ” (*darasu hool qaum*): the people removed all signs of it (obliterated it).

“طَرِيقٌ مَدْرُوسٌ” (*tariqun madroos*) means a path (the signs) that due to the pedestrian traffic has been obliterated.

“دَرَسَ الْخِنْطَةَ” (*darasil hintah*) means to take the cereal out of the ears of corn by having oxen walk over the laid wheat crop which separates the grain from the chaff.

“دَرَسَ” (*darasa*) means to rub something so much that it becomes obliterated.

“دَرَسَ النَّاقَةَ” (*darasan naaqah*) means to walk a camel so much that it becomes obedient.

“الْمُدَارَسَةُ” (*al-mudarasa*) means to strive continuously for something or look after it continuously {T}.

“دَرَسَ الْكِتَابَ يَدْرُسُهُ” (*darasal kitaaba yarusuhu*) means to read a book so many times that one memorizes it.

Surah **Aal-e-Imraan** says:

3:79	Because you have been studying the Book	بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَدْرُسُونَ الْكِتَابَ
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“تَدْرُسُونَ” (*tadrusoon*): to (tread) or read a book in such a way that its meanings become explicitly clear. It means to read something continuously so that the truths hidden in it comes out explicitly and clearly. It may also mean the concepts that receded in Man’s mind, come up to the surface.

Surah **An-Anaam** has used the word “دِرَاسَةً” (*diraasah*) in 6:157 for study with a lot of attention:

6:157	we were truly unaware of studying them	وَأَن كُنَّا عَنْ دِرَاسَتِهِمْ لَغَفِيلِينَ
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D-R-K

درک

Ibn Faris says that the basic meanings of “تَدْرَكَ” (*taraka*) is to pursue something and then join it, reach it, catch it

Surah **Taha** says:

20:77	You shall not fear that (Firoun) shall pursue and catch you	لَا تَخَافُ دَرْكًا
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Surah **Ash-Shurah** says that the fellowship of **Moosa** said:

24:64	Now we are caught	إِنَّا لَمُدْرِكُونَ
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So what they are saying is that they feel that the soldiers of **Firoun** have gained upon them.

“تَدْرَكَ” (*tadaraka*) means to gain upon someone. It has a connotation of keen reaching to something.

Surah **Al-Qalam** says:

68:49	If the benevolence of his Sustainer had not have reached him	لَوْلَا أَنْ تَدَارَكُهُ نِعْمَةٌ
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That is said with regards to the life of **Yunus** which passed through several travails, but God's benevolence and help was continuously with him.

“الدَّرَاكُ” (*ad-draak*): for one thing to continuously follow another.

“التَّدْرِيكُ مِنَ الْمَطَرِ” (*at-tadrikal minal matar*): for the raindrops to fall down continuously (one after another) {T}.

“الدَّرَكُ وَالدَّرَكُ” (*ad-daraka wad darak*): the end of something's depth, bottom of something.

“الدَّرَكُ” (*ad-derku*) means the opposite of “دَرَجٌ” (*darj*). The steps of a ladder are called “دَرَجَاتٌ” (*darajaat*) when used for climbing up, while same steps are called “دَرَكَاتٌ” (*darakaat*) when used for stepping down. {T, M}.

This is why the Quran has termed the stages of the *jannah* as “دَرَجَاتٌ” (*darajaat*), and the stages of *jahannam* as “دَرَكَاتٌ” (*darakat*).

4:145	the bottom of <i>jahannam</i>	فِي الدَّرَكِ الْأَسْفَلِ مِنْ نَّارٍ
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Note that a ladder has the same steps for going up or down. A man can use the very same steps for going up or coming down. Life too is the same way. Whichever way one wants to live, it can be the means of taking it to the resultant destination, whether to the heights or the depths of life.

“أَدْرَكَهُ” (*adrakahu*): reached him, got to him.

“أَدْرَكْتُهُ بِبَصَرِي” (*adaraktuhu be basari*): I found him with my eyes (I spotted him), saw him {T}.

“إِدْرَاكٌ” (*idraak*) is that knowledge which is acquired through the senses.

Surah **Yunus** says:

10:90	When drowning overtook him. (he drowned, when he saw his drowning, when he felt that he was drowning)	حَتَّىٰ إِذَا دَرَكُهُ الْغَرَقُ
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“أَدْرَكَ الشَّيْءُ” (*adrakash shaiyi*): the thing completed its time and was completed, reached its climax {T}.

The Quran says:

27:66	that their knowledge about the Hereafter ended	بَلِ ادْرَكَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ فِي الْآخِرَةِ
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Scholars have said that the above verse means that they could not grasp its whole truth, and remained unaware of the Hereafter {T}.

Raghib says that along with these meanings, it could also mean that they will come to know about it in the Hereafter. But it does not seem to portray the meaning of the verse correctly.

The Quran says that knowledge about the Hereafter has reached them continuously, but still they are in doubt over its existence like the blind in the darkness.

27:66	On the contrary, their knowledge of the Hereafter has declined. They are on the contrary in doubt of it.	بَلْ لَهُمْ فِي شَكٍّ مِنْهَا بَاطِلٌ لَهُمْ مِنْهَا غَمُومٌ
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Darham

درهم

“الْدِرْهَمَ” (*ad-dirham*): a silver coin. The plural is “دِرَاهِمٌ” (*draahem*). This is not an Arabic word. Some say it is actually a *Farsi* (*Persian*) word, and others say it is Greek {T}. But it seems that it is the Arabic form of the Roman word *Drawburg*. Very similar are the words *Deenaar* (*Dinarins*) and *Fils*.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:20	(they sold <i>Yusuf</i>) for a few <i>Dirhams</i>	دِرَاهِمٌ مَّعْذُودَةٌ
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”دَرَيْتُهُ“ (*dareetah*): I now know about him (21:109).

”أَدْرَاهُ بِهِ“ (*adra'o bi*): told him about him {T}.

”دِرَايَةُ“ (*dirayah*) means to find out by some effort or tact or to find about something which is doubtful.

This is the reason that this word is not used for Allah {T}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings include intending and to demand or ask for. It also means “to be sharp”.

As such ”مِدْرَى“ (*midrun*) mean a comb, because its teeth are pointy and sharp. This means ”دِرَايَةُ“ (*dirayah*) contains the meaning of sharpness as well as intention.

Raghib says that wherever Quran says ”مَا أَدْرَاكَ“ (*ma adraaka*) which means “do you know?”, or “has somebody made you aware?” It always follows with an explanation. For example see 97:2. But wherever it says ”مَا يُدْرِيكَ“ (*ma yudreeka*) which means “what tells you?” does not follow with an explanation. Instead, ”لَعَلَّ“ (*la-al*) or perhaps has been said and the subject at hand has been discussed (see 42:17, 33:63, 80:3). This means that after ”مَا أَدْرَاكَ“ (*ma adraaka*), knowledge (about the thing) has been positively given, but after ”مَا يُدْرِيكَ“ (*ma yudreeka*) it is said that ”لَعَلَّ“ (*la'al*) perhaps it can be so.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

97:2	What do you know about <i>lailat-ul-qadr</i> ?	وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا لَيْلَةُ الْقَدْرِ
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After this ”لَيْلَةُ الْقَدْرِ“ (*lailat-ul-qadr*) has been explained.

It is the converse in surah *Ash-Shura*:

42:17	What do you know? Perhaps the time for the revolution is near.	وَمَا يُدْرِيكَ لَعَلَّ السَّاعَةَ قَرِيبٌ
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These examples explain the difference of ”مَا أَدْرَاكَ“ (*ma adraaka*) and ”مَا يُدْرِيكَ“ (*ma yudreeka*).

”دُسُرُ“ (*dusur*) is the plural of ”دِسَارُ“ (*disaar*) which means a nail or a stave.

”دَسَرَ“ (*dasr*) basically means harshness and to push hard {R}.

”دَسَرَ الدِّسَارُ“ (*dasarud dissar*): hammered the nails very hard.

”الدِّسَارُ“ (*ad-disaar*) also means the rope woven from the strands of the date palms with which the boards of a boat are fastened together.

Ibn Faris says this meaning is not right.

”دَسْرَاءُ“ (*dasra-oo*) also means the boat itself {T} because it pushes the water ahead of it as it moves ahead.

The Quran has called the ark of *Nooh* as:

54:13	An ark made of boards and staves	ذَاتَ الْوَاحِ وَدُسُرٍ
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If ”دُسُرُ“ (*dusur*) really means staves, (not a boat of date palm fiber) then it shows that in those days metal had begun to be used and boats too were not made of hollowed out trunks of trees but instead were built from boards and nails. About the boat, it is also said in the Quran that *Nooh's* ark was made under God's guidance or instructions (11:37). Perhaps in those days, this craft too was imparted through divine revelation and then its usage became common.

One hardly knows what human history may reveal. Perhaps many things which we think are the product of human intelligence are actually introduced by divine revelations.

D-S-S/W

د س س / و

“الدَّسُّ” (*ad-das*): to hide something underneath something or bury it {*T*}.

Raghib has added to the meaning by saying that it means to make helpless. That is to force something into something by force {*R*}.

“دَسَسْتُ الشَّيْءَ فِي التُّرَابِ” (*dasastu shaiyi fit turaab*): I hid the thing in the ground {*T*}.

Surah **An-Nahal** says that during the period of unawareness when the Arabs got news about the birth of a girl child, their thought was:

16:59	Perhaps he should bury her in the ground	أَمْ يَدُسُّهُ فِي التُّرَابِ
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Surah **Ash-Shams** says about human intention:

91:10	He who developed it (on the right lines) became successful (his fields bore fruit)	قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ رَزَّاهَا
91:11	He who buried it became unsuccessful	وَقَدْ خَابَ مَنْ دَسَّاهَا

For a seed to develop, it must be buried in the ground. If the proportion of water, earth, air, temperature and light is correct, then the seed develops and blossoms into a strong tree. But if the same seed is buried too deep, it loses all its capabilities. The human personae have been endowed with latent capabilities to develop, but these capabilities are developed in this physical world. If physical forces are used properly then human personality's latent talents are developed. If the personality is buried under self-interests, then its capabilities are stultified.

“دَسَّيْ” (*dassa*) was actually “دَسَسَ” (*dassasa*). Since three “س” (*seen*) together are not feasible, the word has become “دَسَّى” (*dassa*).

Fara and **Zajaj** say this means miserliness. Because a miser hides himself while a philanthropist is open and prominent, this meaning is in one way right. The Quran has itself said the development of a human being is in giving, while miserliness has been described as a reason for destruction.

92:5-10	Then as for him who gives and believes in the best. Then we will ease him towards ease, but as for who withholds and considers himself free from need and denies the best. Then We will ease him towards difficulty.	فَأَمَّا مَنْ أَعْطَى وَاتَّقَى وَصَدَّقَ بِالْحُسْنَى فَسَنُيَسِّرُهُ لِلْيُسْرَى وَأَمَّا مَنْ بَخِلَ وَاسْتَغْنَى وَكَذَّبَ بِالْحُسْنَى فَسَنُيَسِّرُهُ لِلْعُسْرَى
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This is what **rabubiyah** (providence) is. That is, to develop oneself by providing for others and this is what the Quran teaches us to do.

With regards to hiding “الدَّسِّيْسَةُ” (*ad-dasyasah*) is that misconception and fraud that is hidden, or a thing that enters secretly {*M*}.

The linguists have said “دَسَّاهَا” (*dassaha*) comes from the root (**D-S-S**) as well as (**D-S-Y**). This is the reason why we have included both roots under the same heading.

“الدَّعْ” (*ad-da'a*): to push hard.

“دَاعِ دَاعِ” (*daa-ee, daa'ee*): an admonishing voice for the goatherd.

“الدَّعَاغُ” (*ad-da'a*): a man's small children {T} (for which he is pushed around in society).

The Quran says:

107:6	this is him who pushes (away) the orphans	فَذَٰلِكَ الَّذِي يُدْعُ الْيَتِيمَ
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Surah *At-Toor* says:

52:13	The day when they will be pushed hard towards the fire of <i>jahannam</i> (hell)	يَوْمَ يُدْعُونَ إِلَىٰ نَارِ جَهَنَّمَ دَعَاً
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Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of the word is to push and unease.

Consider the verse of surah *Al-Ma'on* once again:

107:1	Have you ever wondered about the man who denies this way of life?	أَرَأَيْتَ الَّذِي يُكَذِّبُ بِالْءَدِينِ
107:2	this is him who pushes (away) the orphans	فَذَٰلِكَ الَّذِي يُدْعُ الْيَتِيمَ
107:3	and does not pursued (others too) for feeding the destitute	وَلَا يَخْضُ عَلَىٰ طَعَامِ الْمِسْكِينِ

Note how closely the way of Islam (*Deen*) and economics are related. This relationship is even found in *salaah* and economics as well, because the next verse says that there is destruction for those who are unaware of the true meaning of *salaah*.

People like this offer their prayers, thinking that it is *salaah*, but build barriers against the sources of sustenance and prevent them from reaching the needy, although they (the resources) should be like flowing water, available for everybody. (Further details will be found under relevant headings).

“دَعَا” (*da'a*) means to call someone.

“الدَّعَاءُ” (*ad-da'ah*) means the forefinger which is used as a sign to call someone.

“الدَّاعِيَةُ” (*ad-dayiah*) means the cry of the horses in battle.

“هُوَ مَنَىٰ دَعْوَةً لِّرَجُلٍ” (*huwaminni dawatar rajul*): He is at a distance where a man's voice can reach him. He is at a calling distance {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to incline towards oneself through talk or voice.

“دَعَاهُ إِلَى الْأَمِيرِ” (*dayahu ila al-ameer*): he took him towards the leader.

“دَاعٍ” (*dayi*) is not only one who calls but also someone who takes you to someone {T}.

“إِدْعَاءُ” (*iddia'oo*), “يَدْعُونَ” (*yad-da'oon*) means to wish or desire {T}, or to call out to someone (67:28).

“تَدَاعَوْا عَلَيْهِ” (*tadau alaih*): means they gathered against him.

“تَدَاعَىٰ عَلَيْهِ الْعَدُوُّ مِنْ كُلِّ جَانِبٍ” (*tada'a alaihal aduwu min kulli jaanib*) means the enemy attacked him from all sides.

“تَدَاعَتْ الْحِيطَانُ” (*tadaa'atil haitaan*) means the walls fell down one after another {T}.

“دَعَوْتُهُ زَيْدًا” (*da'autuhu zaida*): I named him *Zaid*.

“الدَّعِي” (*ad-dayee'o*): adopted son {T}, plural is “الدَّعِيَاءُ” (*addia'o*) as in 33:4.

“الدَّعِيَّةُ” (*ad-daayiah*): is the milk that is left behind in the teats of animals so that with its help the animal can be milked again {T}. It also means the reason, or cause.

“الدَّوَاعِي” (*ad-dawa'ee*): such things as tempt or instigate people's emotions or desires {M}.

These meanings should be kept in mind because they throw light on the meaning of the word “دُعَاءُ” (*dua*), or prayer/supplication.

2:23	call those who may help you	وَادْعُوا شُرَكَاءَكُمْ
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In surah *Kahaf*, “نَادَى” (*nadyaa*) and “دَعَا” (*da'a*) have been used in a similar meaning as in 18:25.

In surah *Airaaf*, “صَمَتَ” (*samat*), which means to be quiet, has been used against “دَعَا” (*da'a*) in 7:193.

As such “دَعَا” (*da'a*) would mean to call.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:61	Call out to your God on our behalf	فَادْعُوا لَنَا رَبَّنَا
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“الدَّعْوَى” (*ad-da'wyaa*): to call out, demand, require (10:10)

We have now come to that part of “دَعَا” (*da'a*), considered to be prayers, which has been taxed as the most complicated one in the world of scholars and religion, because its explicit meaning has not been given. Consider an example. In some case, **Zaid** is the Prosecution and **Bakar** the **Defence**. **Zaid** prays to God that the case is decided in his favor. This raises the following questions:

- One group of people believes that all matters are decided beforehand by God. If this is taken to be correct, then it would mean that it has already been decided that the case will be decided in **Zaid's** favour or against. If it was decided by God beforehand, then **Zaid's** prayer will not change God's already made decision and **Zaid** will now not win the case if he was already destined to lose it.

If this is not so, then it would mean that God changes His decisions according to men's prayer or bidding. This would then imply that He is obedient to men. This concept cannot be right in any case.

- Now if we suppose that **Zaid's** claim in the case was false or fabricated, would then God decide the case in his favor because he prayed? If this is true, then it would mean that God decided in favor of a liar and deprived the truthful from his right. This concept too about God is wrong.
- Suppose that **Zaid** is justified in his claim. Now if **Zaid** does not pray to God, then would the case be decided in his favor or not? If the case cannot be decided in his favor without praying then it would mean that God does not decide in favor of the truth on His own. The truthful has to plead before God in order to obtain a decision in his favor even though he did nothing wrong. This concept too about God is wrong. If God decides in favor of truth, then it does not make a difference whether **Zaid** prays or not. God in any case had to decide in his favor (that is, in favor of the truth). As such, praying is a useless effort!
- It is obvious that in order to win a case, a man has to make some effort, however ethical. Now if **Zaid** only prays, and does not make the required effort, will he win the case? If praying is enough to win the case then it would mean that God's stress on effort (deed) is useless? Also if one cannot win the case without making the required effort, then what is the usage of any praying?
- If **Zaid** prays to God and **Bakar** does it as well, then in whose favor will the case be decided? Whose prayer will God accept?

These questions and many others arise with regards to the concept of praying to God, where religions and philosophers have been trying to solve or answer these questions for centuries, but with no luck.

Please note that the term religion is a manmade concept while following Gods instructions is called **Deen**.

The Quran has said that this concept of *dua* or praying is wrong and a product of the time when man was in his infant stage and was unaware of the law of causality.

The Quran clarified that:

- 1) Everything in the universe is operating according to the order created by God. He never changes His laws. “وَلَنْ تَجِدَ لِسَنَةِ اللَّهِ تَغْيِيلًا” (*walan tajeda sunnatillahi tabdeelah*) (33:64), i.e. “You will not find any change in God’s laws”.
- 2) It is God’s law which is operative in man’s world as well. He who strives as much under these laws will succeed proportionately. “لَيْسَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ إِلَّا مَا سَعَىٰ” (*laisa lil insaana illa ma sa’a, wa unna sa’yahu saufa yura*). 53:39-40, i.e. “There is nothing for man other than what he works for, and the result of his efforts will soon be made manifest”.

At the same time, the Quran has made it clear to believe that simply by praying (and not making any effort), one’s wish is granted, is an erroneous concept about God.

Surah *Ar-Raad* says “لَهُ دَعْوَةُ الْحَقِّ” (*lahu dawatul haq*). This means that human invitation which can produce successful results, which can be said to be based on truth, is the same invitation with which you invite someone towards your sustainer (according to His law and order).

“وَالَّذِينَ يَدْعُونَ مِنْ دُونِهِ لَا يَسْتَجِيبُونَ لَهُمْ بِشَيْءٍ” (*wallazeena yad’ona min doonehi la yastajeebuna lahum bish shaiyi*): those who attach their wishes to others beside God, that is, believe that by leaving aside the Laws of God, they can succeed on the basis of their superstitions, are wrong. These self-created forces can never fulfill their wishes.

Such people can be likened to “كَبَّاسِطٍ كَفَّيْهِ إِلَى الْمَاءِ لِيَبْلُغَ فَاهُ وَمَا يُوْ بِبَالِغِهِ” (*kabasiti kaffiyahi ilal ma-ee liyab lugha fa hu wama huwa bi-balighihi*): as if a man sits beside a river and prays that the water may come into his mouth, the water will never come into his mouth on its own. As such, “وَمَا دُعَاءُ الْكَافِرِينَ إِلَّا فِي ضَلَالٍ” (*wama dua-ool kafireena illa fi zalaal*) 13:14: Those who deny God’s verses or God’s sayings, their praying can never produce results.

Do you not see that “وَلِلَّهِ يَسْجُدُ مَنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ طَوْعًا وَكَرْهًا” (*walil lahi mun fis samawaati wal ardi tau-an wa karha*) 3:15: everything in the universe, willingly or not, has to operate according to the Laws of God. Then how can man be an exception to this?

As such, according to the Quran, calling out to God means calling out to the Laws of God for help. That is, by obeying them in order to find the desired results. This fact has been clarified at various points in the Quran.

For example the Quran says in surah Momineen:

	Your Sustainer says “Call out to me, I will respond to your call”	وَقَالَ رَبُّكُمْ ادْعُونِي أَسْتَجِبْ لَكُمْ
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The meaning of the above verse will be explained a little further ahead. After this, it is said:

40:60	Indeed, those who refuse to accept my authority enter the state of <i>jahannum</i> after distress and humiliation	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَسْتَكْبِرُونَ عَنْ عِبَادَتِي سَيَدْخُلُونَ جَهَنَّمَ دَاخِرِينَ
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This explains what is meant by calling out to God. It means to accept and to obey Him and His superiority. His answer to the call means for man’s efforts to bear fruit.

This fact has been described at another place as:

32:15	Those who trust Us, (have faith in Us) are those who gladly bow their heads (in subservience) when they are presented with our orders, and are engaged in establishing and making praiseworthy the program given by their Sustainer, and they do not defy these orders.	إِنَّمَا يُؤْمِنُ بِآيَاتِنَا الَّذِينَ إِذَا دُكِّرُوا بِهَا خَرُّوا سُجَّدًا وَسَبَّحُوا بِحَمْدِ رَبِّهِمْ وَهُمْ لَا يَسْتَكْبِرُونَ
32:16	They are so busy in this work that they do not even consider sleep, are awake at night, and Thus, call on their Sustainer for removing their problems and for His benevolence. Because they know that their efforts will cause good results, and what destruction will follow if the orders are disobeyed. Whatever We have given them, is kept open (available) to the human race (for their welfare).	تَتَجَافَى جُنُوبُهُمْ عَنِ الْمَضَاجِعِ - يَدْعُونَ رَبَّهُمْ خَوْفًا وَطَمَعًا وَمِمَّا رَزَقْنَاهُمْ يُنفِقُونَ

Surah *Al-momin* says:

40:65	When you call out to God, then call Him with full and complete obedience only for Him	فَادْعُوهُ مُخْلِصِينَ لَهُ الدِّينَ---
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Surah *Ash-Shura* says:

42:26	He responds to the call of those people who believe on His laws and work according to them	وَيَسْتَجِيبُ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ---
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This shows too, what calling to God and His response means.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:55	Call your Sustainer with complete equanimity of heart and soul. so that the call comes from the core of your heart	أَدْعُوا رَبَّكُمْ تَضَرُّعًا وَخُفْيَةً إِنَّهُ لَا يُحِبُّ الْمُعْتَدِينَ
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Note that those who rebel against His laws and cross the limits are disliked by Him. This also shows that “calling” Him means “obeying Him”. The next verses explain this:

7:56	Do not create ripples in society after it has become smooth or calm	وَلَا تُفْسِدُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ بَعْدَ إِصْلَاحِهَا
7:57	And call out to God for banishing your problems and ills and for acquiring benefits. Remember that those who maintain the balance in society, Allah’s benevolence is very near to them	وَادْعُوهُ خَوْفًا وَطَمَعًا إِنَّ رَحْمَتَ اللَّهِ قَرِيبٌ مِّنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ

Here Allah’s benevolence is said to be ‘near’. In surah *Al-Baqrah* God Himself is said to be near:

2:186	And when my obedient ask you about Me, tell them I am not far from them, and are very near.	وَإِذَا سَأَلَكَ عِبَادِي عَنِّي فَإِنِّي قَرِيبٌ
2:186	Thus, they should obey Me and believe in the veracity of my laws so that they find the path to their destinations.	فَلْيَسْتَجِيبُوا لِي وَلْيُؤْمِنُوا بِي لَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْشُدُونَ
50:16	(I am) closer than their jugular vein	أُجِيبُ دَعْوَةَ الدَّاعِ إِذَا دَعَانِ

This also makes explicit that “calling out” to God means “obeying” Him, and the response to that call is the result of those efforts which one makes according to His laws.

In surah **An-Namal**, first the attention has been drawn to various elements of the universal system as to how everything happens according to God's order (system). Then, the group of **momineen** has been addressed which was passing through very difficult times in its initial stages of establishing God's orders, and was calling out at every step for help from God.

“مَتَٰ نَصْرُ اللَّهِ” (*mata nasrullah*): when shall God's help come? (2:214)

They were told (through revelation, of course):

27:62	(except God) who can hear or answer your cries for help; and remove your worries and difficulties, and grant you the rule on this earth but the rule on earth can only be gotten as a result of your deeds	أَمَّنْ يُجِيبُ الْمُضْطَرَّ إِذَا دَعَاهُ وَيَكْشِفُ السُّوءَ وَيَجْعَلُكُمْ خُلَفَاءَ الْأَرْضِ
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Thus, do not worry, keep working according to God's laws, he will turn your helplessness into dominance, and if you continue on this path (the path of God) then Our cosmic forces will save you from the harmful machinations of your opponents (40:7). Not only was the group of **momineen** told this, but the messengers as well.

In surah **Yunus**, in the tale of **Moosa**, **Moosa** and his brother **Haroon**, who also was a messenger, pray to God to confront **Firoun** successfully. They are told that:

10:89	the prayers of you both have been accepted	قَدْ أَجَبْنَاهُ دَعْوَانِكُمَا فَاَسْتَجَبْنَاهُ
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This means that they were told to continue with their program (as given by God) with steadfastness. Obviously if the acceptance of prayer meant only that whatever you have asked for shall be given to you, (or you will get it), then after that there was no need for any effort. However here it has been said that your prayer has been accepted, Therefore, be steadfast in your program. This makes it obvious, that **Moosa** and his brother **Haroon** were only told that their call-outs are according to God's laws, and now they should strive to achieve those ends with steadfastness and Hence, they would surely succeed.

The above explanations make it clear that calling out to God means obeying his orders and laws. The Messenger Mohammed (*pbuh*) was also asked to 'call out God', to do **dua**:

72:20	Tell them that I only call out to my Sustainer and do not include anyone else with Him (do not include anyone in His Supreme authority) (18:26)	قُلْ إِنَّمَا أَدْعُوا رَبِّي وَلَا أُشْرِكُ بِهِ أَحَدًا
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After this Quranic meaning of '**dua**', there is no cause left for the doubts and tribulations mentioned earlier about '**dua**'.

The Quran also relates the things similar to what we mean by '**dua**' in the ordinary sense:

3:146	O Sustainer, protect us from our faults and transgressions. Give solidarity to our feet (us) and give us success over the nation of deniers	رَبَّنَا اغْفِرْ لَنَا ذُنُوبَنَا وَإِسْرَافَنَا فِي أَمْرِنَا وَثَبِّتْ أَقْدَامَنَا وَانصُرْنَا عَلَى الْقَوْمِ الْكَافِرِينَ
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That is such prayers (**dua**) in which a man desires fulfillment of his wishes. These prayers are actually a manifest of the intensity of his wishes. This intensity creates a kind of a change in his personality that gives vent to his latent capabilities and they go to work for him. Consider the meanings of the words “الدَّاعِيَةُ” (*ad-dayituh*) and “الدَّوَاعِي” (*ad-dawayi*) given earlier. First a man must desire that which is according to God's laws (not the obverse). Then he should create intensity in his wishes. This will create a revolutionary condition within himself and the result is indeed surprising. Note that the Quran has also said that your wishes must be according to the laws of God or you may wish for something that in reality is harmful for you (17:11).

It can be argued that by praying revolutionary changes are created in man himself which help him to attain his goals. Then what is the difference in calling out to God or praying to Him? It is correct that

man's latent capabilities are aroused in this way, but the aim is not only to raise the latent forces or capabilities as such. The first thing is to determine the aim for which they are aroused. That is, the purpose for the attainment of which the effort is being made, and what sort is that aim? Then, what are the means to achieve it, and what will the purpose be, if attained? A **momin** (one who follows the Quran) decides all matters under the orders of Allah and Therefore, keeps Allah before him from first to last. His wish or desire is also a link in this chain. Therefore, he calls out to God for its attainment too. Everything takes place as per God's laws, so much so that the latent forces in man are aroused too as a result of His laws.

Another point to be noted here is that God has bestowed man with that a personality with the proper development of which (to the extent that is humanly possible) can arouse the qualities which when unbounded, are attributable to God. In this manner, God's personality becomes the standard for the development of the human personality. By praying to God (by calling out to Him) a man wants to arouse the qualities within himself that will help him attain his goal. This is the difference between 'praying to God' and arousing intense desire in oneself.

We now come to the praying of the messengers mentioned in the Quran. Messenger-hood is quite different from ordinary human matters. We cannot understand anything about it. We only understand the message that they have brought to us and their obedience is our duty. As far as God talking to them in response to their prayers is concerned, it does not happen with ordinary human beings. God does not talk to anyone except the messengers to believe that He does, even after the last Messenger (pbuh), is blasphemy.

The concept that if God does not listen to our pleadings, Therefore, someone close to God should be requested to pray for us before God is not correct.

As per the Quran, no power can interfere between God and His missionaries. To believe so is a big sin. To reach God or to take one's pleading to God, no media is required. Every human being by obeying God's laws can reach God or take his voice to Him. To see the meaning of "وسيله" (*waseela*), or means, go to relevant heading. His laws are obeyed by remaining within the bounds of a Quranic society. That is the reason that the prayers that God has taught the **momineen** are mostly collective. Such as 1:5, 1:7, 2:201, 3:7, 3:146, and 3:192 etc.).

To explain verses 2:186 and 50:16 as mentioned above. These verses contain hints to His imminence and transcendence. He is closer to every human being than his jugular vein. This shows that God is present everywhere in the universe, but not present as something is bound to some place. Since our senses are unable to grasp how God can be present somewhere in space without occupying some space, Therefore, it has been said in the Quran that:

6:104	human eyes cannot comprehend Him	لَا تُدْرِكُهُ الْأَبْصَارُ، وَهُوَ يُدْرِكُ الْأَبْصَارَ
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But it is encircling or comprehending human sight. But we can comprehend His laws and can observe their results as well. Therefore, the Quran has said that we are connected to God's laws. We call out to His laws and when we act according to His laws, He answers our call by bringing the desired results that we have called for.

As far as God's knowledge is concerned, the thing that we term as past, present or future, have no place according to the laws of God. Before God, all the past, present and the future are revealed at the same time. There is a sort of eternal now. That is, He is aware of future events or what will take place in the future (future for us) as if they are taking place now. But it makes no difference as to our intent or authority which we have been given by God. Nor is the fact affected that whatever happens to us is the result of our own deeds. Everything is taking place before God. He also knows what we are going to do, but he does not interfere with our intent or authority. We do what we chose to, and face whatever results our own deeds bring. If we act according to God's laws then we get good results, if we go against these laws then we suffer. Nobody has the power to do wrong and reap good results. To observe God's laws is to call out to Him or pray to Him and to get good results means our prayers have been answered.

”الدَّفْعُ“ (*ad-dif'u*): temperature and heat, or something that heats something.
 ”أَدْفَأَهُ“ (*adfaahu*): he attired him in such clothes as to warm him.
 ”الدَّفَاءُ“ (*ad-difa'u*): anything that provides heat.

The Quran says about cattle:

16:5	They have the wherewithal to provide heat and have other benefits.	لَكُمْ فِيهَا دِفٌّ وَمَنْفَعٌ
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Ibn Faris says that ”دَفَى“ (*dafun*) means the camel's kids, its milk and its other beneficial things.

”دَفَعَ“ (*dafah*): to banish something by force, to remove, as in 2:251 {*T, R*}.

Muheet says ”الدَّفْعُ“ (*ad-dafah*) means to banish something before it takes place and ”الرَّفْعُ“ (*ar-rafah*) means to remove it after it takes place.

Basa-ir says when ”دَفَعَ“ (*dafah*) is followed by ”إِلَى“ (*ila*) then it means to entrust or to pay back. As in:

4:9	return their goods or wealth to them	فَادْعُوا إِلَيْهِمْ أَمْوَالَهُمْ
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When it is followed by ”عَنْ“ (*un*), then it means to support or protect {*T*}.

22:38	Verily God (God's law) protects those who Believe on His reality	إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُدَافِعُ عَنِ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا
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”الْمُدَافَعَةُ“ (*al-mudaafi'atu*): to jostle one another and to push {*T*}.

”دَافِعٌ“ (*daafiun*): one who removes (70:2)?

”دَفَقَ الْمَاءُ يَدْفُقُ“ (*dafaqal ma'a yudfiqu*): he spilled the water.

”دَفَقَ الْكَوْزُ“ (*dafaqal kooz*): spilled the water of the cup at once.

”دَفَقَ الْمَاءُ“ (*dafaqul ma'o*): the water boiled suddenly.

”سَيْلٌ دَفَاقٌ“ (*sailun dafaag*): the flood whose waters overflowed the valley.

”الدَّفْقُ“ (*ad-difaqu*): a fast camel.

”الدَّفْقُ“ (*ad-difaqqa*): a fast speed in which the animal jumps when running {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to push forward.

The Quran speaks about the creation of man.

86:6	He has been created from the surfing liquid (sperm).	خَلَقَ مِنْ مَّاءٍ دَافِقٍ
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”الْدَكُّ“ (*ad-dok*): to break, to pound, to demolish a wall or mountain. Actually it means to pound and break a thing and level it with the ground {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris thinks it means to become low and to spread out.

”الْدَكَّةُ“ (*ad-dakkatu*), ”الْدُكُّ“ (*ad-duk*): smooth or even place, or to level the ups and downs of the ground. (To beat them into a level with the ground) {*T, M*}.

89:21	When the land's unevenness (ups and downs) will be removed and made level.	إِذَا دُكَّتِ الْأَرْضُ دَكًّا دَكًّا
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In other words when the balance of economy shall be made even, and there will be no ups and downs {*T*}.

69:14	The evenness will be made in one go	فَدُكَّنَا دَكَّةً وَاحِدَةً
7:143	Smoothed it, removed the ups and downs or high or lows or unevenness.	جَعَلَهُ دَكًّا
18:98	Will break it and make it level (here the word 'earth' is silent for which <i>dakka</i> has been said)	جَعَلَهُ دَكًّا

”الْدَكَّا“ (*ad-dakka'o*) means a mud dune or hill {*T*}.

”جَعَلَهُ دَكًّا“ (*ja'alahu dakka'a*) would mean that the wall becomes like a dune when demolished.

”أَرْضٌ دَكَّا“ (*ardun dakka'o*): smooth land {*R*}.

”الْدُكَّانُ“ (*ad-dukaan*): a place the top of which is smoothed over for sitting {*T, M*}.

”دَلَكَهُ بِيَدِهِ دَلَكًا“ (*dalakahu beyadehi dalka*): to rub something with the hands.

”دَلَكَتِ الشَّمْسُ دُلُوكًا“ (*dalakatis shamsu duluka*): sunset, because one who looks at it starts rubbing his eyes with his hands {*T*} (but we think that this reasoning is feeble).

”دُلُوكًا“ (*dalakat duluka*): for the sun to become yellowish and go towards sunset, or for the sun to lean towards the west (towards setting) after mid noon in the middle of the sky {*M*}.

Azhari says this is the right meaning because in Arabic ”دُلُوكٌ“ (*dulook*) means decline. *Ibn Faris* too seems to agree with this as he says the word means for a thing to move away (decline) from something else. But he also says that the word contains the connotation of something moving away softly. This word is also used for rubbing because in that state hands do not stay in one place.

Alwasi writes in *Roohul Ma'ani* that the word means to transfer from one place to another. So sunrise as well as sunset is ”دُلُوكٌ“ (*dulook*) because both ways it moves away. When the sun has reached its peak and starts setting, it is called ”دَالِكًا“ (*dalikah*), as well as it has set, because in both conditions it is in decline.

Nawaderul Airaab says it means for the sun to be high or low.

Ibn Faris says that wherever ”د“ (*daal*) appears along with ”ل“ (*laam*), the word means to move, to come or go, and to decline from one place to another. As such ”دَلَكَتِ الثُّوبُ“ (*dalakatis saub*) would mean rubbed the cloth while washing it.

”دَلَكَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ الْعَجِينُ“ (*dalakatil mar-atul ajeen*): the woman prepared the dough.

”تَدَلَّلَكَ الرَّجُلُ“ (*tadallakar rajul*): he rubbed his body while bathing.

“الدُّلُوكُ” (*ad-dalook*): to rub perfume or balm etc.

“بَعِيرٌ مَدْلُوكٌ” (*baeerum medlook*): a camel which has been used for traveling constantly.

“الدَّالِيكُ” (*ad-deek*): to walk fast without the full feet touching the ground {T}

All these meanings show that the real meaning of this root is movement. As such when the sun rises to its peak in the noon, is also called “دُلُوكٌ” (*dulook*) (as has been mentioned with reference to *Nawadarul Airaab* above). And when it starts setting after reaching its peak, will also be called “دُلُوكٌ” (*dulook*) as mentioned above.

Raghib too, says it means leaning towards the sunset

Ibn Dureed says in Jamharatil Lagha that it means to set and disappear.

The Quran says:

17:78	Establish the <i>salaah</i> from <i>duluk</i> of the sun to <i>ghasaqil lail</i> , and Quran is of the <i>Fajr</i> . (ordinary meaning)	اقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ لِلدُّلُوكِ الشَّمْسِ إِلَى غَسَقِ اللَّيْلِ وَفُرْآنِ الْفَجْرِ
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If “دُلُوكٌ” (*dulook*) here is taken to mean ordinary movement then it covers the entire time from sunrise to sunset, and “فُرْآنِ الْفَجْرِ” (*Quran-ul-Fajr*) i.e. before sunrise to “غَسَقِ اللَّيْلِ” (*ghasaqil lail*) i.e. after sunset. The meaning is obvious that this whole period is available to you for *salaah*. And if “دُلُوكٌ” (*duluk*) is taken to mean from the sun’s decline to sunset then (according to the above meaning) the time between sunrise and half the day will be eliminated.

At another place regarding establishment of *salaah* it is said:

11:114	both ends of the day and night (in the earlier part)	طَرَفِي النَّهَارِ وَزُلْفَا مِنَ اللَّيْلِ
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Both ends of the day are *fajar* which is before sunrise, and *maghrib* which is time of sunset. The earlier part of the night is *ghasaqil lail*.

Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:58	The <i>salaah</i> of <i>fajar</i>	صَلَاةُ الْفَجْرِ
24:58	the <i>salaah</i> of <i>ish’a</i>	صَلَاةُ الْعِشَاءِ

These have been mentioned specifically. It is obvious from the above then that in the time of *Mohammed* (pbuh), *salaah* congregations were held at these two timings which was the time from morning to evening, or from the time of the decline to evening.

“دُلُوكٌ” (*dulook*) according to the earlier meaning (i.e. the time from morning to evening) seems more appropriate linguistically.

“غَسَقٌ” (*ghasaq*) means twilight. See heading (*Gh-S-Q*).

Salaah does not only mean timely congregations. It also means the Quranic system or the life as determined by the Quran. According to this, if in this verse (17:78) too, *salaah* is taken to mean the duties imposed by the Quranic system, then it would mean that from the first day consider what guidance the Quran gives you (this will be *Quran ul-fajr*), and then engage in complying with the Quranic program from morning till evening. This will be establishing of *salaah* from early morning to late night.

“دَلُّ الْمَرْأَةِ وَدَّ لَا لَهَا عَلَى زَوْجِهَا” (*dall ul-mar’ati wa dalaluha ala zaujiha*): for wife to be coy with her husband, to act as if she is defying her husband, without really doing so.
 “دَلَّهُ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*dallahu alash shaiyi*): told him something, led him to something.
 “أَدَّلَ عَلَيْهِ” (*adalla alaihi*): became informal with him, became bold with him, due to complete trust on his love even committed excesses on him/her.
 “أَدَّالَهُ” (*ad-d’allah*): coyness.
 “أَدَّلَى” (*ad-dulla*): distinct path.
 “أَدْلِيلٌ” (*ad-daleel*): landmark which leads to a destination and the thing that clarifies something.
 “أَدْلَالُهُ” (*ad-dalalah*): to show someone the way, and to herald something with the signs.

Raghib says it means something which leads to an understanding of something else {T, M, R}
Ibn Faris says it means to disclose something by its signs which you conclude after much deliberation. That is, the expression of truth through signs. It also means for movement or unease to be present in something. The Quran says you do not ponder upon the “حِكْمَهُ” (hikmah) or scheme of your Sustainer. That, for instance causes the elongation of shadows.

Later it is said:

25:45	The elongation or shortening of the shadows is due to the sunlight.	ثُمَّ جَعَلْنَا الشَّمْسُ عَلَيْهِ دَلِيلًا
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If there is no sunlight, then there would be no shadow, and its reduction or elongation would not be visible.

Surah **Saba** says:

34:14	Nothing made aware of Suleman’s death except....	مَا دَّاهَهُمْ عَلَى مَوْتِهِ إِلَّا--
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I.e. that thing, after long deliberation, led to the conclusion that **Suleman** had actually expired.

(Details will be found under the heading **Suleman**). As such, reasoning is something which upon deliberation can lead gradually to a conclusion.

“أَدَّلُو” (*ad-dalwu*): bucket (of a well). When it is filled with water, it is called “ذَنُوبٌ” (*zanoob*) {M, T}, but it is not a rule.
 “أَدْلَيْتُ” (*adlait*): I dropped the bucket into the water {T}, or brought it out filling it with water {L}. This led to “أَدْلَى” (*adla*) which means to provide the means to reach something. Just as to reach the water of the well, one has to drop the bucket inside the well.
 “أَدْلَى إِلَيْهِ بِمَالِهِ” (*adla ilaihi bimaalehi*): gave him his wealth {T}.
 “أَدْلَى حَاجَتَهُ دَلْوًا” (*dala haajatuhu dalwa*): he demanded what he wanted or needed.
 “أَدْلَى بِرَحْمِهِ” (*adla berahmehi*): he used his relationship as a means to getting his work done {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to approach something with softness and ease.

The Quran has said:

2:188	To reach the authorities through wealth (via bribe) and to receive a judgment in one’s favored.	تَدُلُّوْهُمَ إِلَى الْحُكَامِ
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“تَدَلَّى” (*tadalla*) also means to hang, to be near.

Surah *An-Najam* mentions:

53:8	He got near, became of the same color, and was lost in the depths of the truth.	ثُمَّ دَنَا فَتَدَلَّى
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This is a particularity of messenger-hood.

Surah *Al-Airaaaf* has this:

7:22	Deceived them to fall into the depths.	فَدَاغَهُمْ يَغُورٌ
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“دَالَاهُ” (*dalaahu*), “مُدَالَاهُ” (*mudalaah*): was soft (courteous) to him {*M*}.
 “دَلِي” (*daliya*), “يَدْلِي” (*yadla*): to be surprised {*T*}.

D-M-D-M

د م د م

“دَمَدَمَ الْقَوْمَ وَدَمَدَمَ عَلَيْهِمْ” (*damdamal qauma wa damdama alihim*): the nation was destroyed and annihilated.
 “دَمَدَمَ عَلَيْهِ” (*damdama alaih*): was angry at him and talked to him angrily {*T*}.
 “دَمَدَمَ عَلَيْهِمْ” (*damdama alihim*): they were annihilated and troubled {*T*}, {*Latif-ul-Lugha*}.
 “الدَّمَدَمَةُ” (*ad-damdamatu*): troublesome talk, anger {*T*}. It also means to destroy {*Latif-ul-Lugha*}.
 “الدَّمَدَمُ” (*ad-damdam*): dry grass {*T*}.
 “دَمَدَمَ الرَّعْدُ” (*damdamar raad*): there was strong thunder {*L*}.

The Quran mentions:

91:13	Their Sustainer (the natural turn of events) killed them in such a way that even their traces were obliterated.	فَدَمَدَمَ عَلَيْهِمْ رَبُّهُمْ
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D-M-R

د م ر

“الدُّمُورُ” (*ad-dumoor*), “الدَّمَارُ” (*ad-damaar*): to be killed, to kill.
 “التَّدْمِيرُ” (*at-tadmeer*): to kill, to root out.

Raghib says it means to instill destruction into something.

“دَمَرَ عَلَيْهِ” (*damara alihim*): he came near him without permission (and with malicious intent). He suddenly attacked him {*T*}.

The Quran says:

7:137	We destroyed	وَدَمَرْنَا
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Ibn Faris says the basic meanings are to enter a house etc. Some add that this entry is without permission.

D-M-Ain

د م ع

“الدَّمْعُ” (*ad-dam'o*): tears, whether they are of joy or sorrow.
 “الدَّمْعَةُ” (*ad-dam'atuh*): a tear.
 “دَمَعَتِ الْعَيْنُ” (*dama'atil ain*): the eyes became moist {*T*}.
 “دَمَعَتِ السَّحَابَةُ” (*dam'atis sahabah*): it rained from the clouds {*T*}.

Surah *Al-Mai'dah* says:

5:83	You will find that tears begin to roll down their eyes	تَرَىٰ أَعْيُنُهُمْ تَفِيضُ مِنَ الدَّمْعِ
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“الْدِّمَاغُ” (*ad-dimagh*) means he brain.

“دَمَغَ” (*damagha*), “يَدْمَغُ” (*yadmagh*): he injured him in such a way that the wound reached the brain.

“الْدَّامُوعُ” (*ad-damogh*): the thing which breaks or destroys something else.

“دَمَغَهُ” (*damagha hu*): he overpowered him {T}.

“دَمَغَ الْحَقُّ الْبَاطِلَ” (*damaghul haqqul baatil*): the truth obliterated the untruth, or destroyed it {T}.

“حُجَّةٌ دَامِغَةٌ” (*hujjatun daamigha*): mind boggling reason {R}.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says that *haqq* (undeniable truth) destroys the *baatil* (the falsehood).

In the struggle between truth and untruth (*haqq* and *baatil*), good and evil, that is perpetual in the universe, *haqq* (the constructive element) always overpowers *baatil* (destructive element) and so on. If the destructive element was overpowering then leave alone the evolution of the universe, the universe itself would cease to exist.

21:18	We strike the <i>baatil</i> with <i>haqq</i> , so that <i>haqq</i> destroys the <i>baatil</i> .	بَلْ نَقْذِفُ بِالْحَقِّ عَلَى الْبَاطِلِ فَيَدْمَغُهُ فَإِذَا هُوَ زَاهِقٌ
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So see how *baatil* is being destroyed. It is the law of nature for constructive program to overcome destructive forces. It cannot be otherwise. But the speed at which these constructive forces overcome is (according to our standards) very slow. God's single day is equal to one thousand (or rather fifty thousand of our) years (32:5, 70:4). But if man becomes a friend of God, then the results start to be formulated according to our measure.

“دَمٌ” (*dum*) means blood.

“الْدِّمَاءُ” (*ad-dima'a*) is the plural as in 2:30 {T}.

“دَمٌ” (*dum*) was actually “دَمُو” (*damu*) or “دَمِي” (*damun*). The Quran has declared “دَمًا مَسْفُوحًا” (*duman masfoohan*) in 6:146 i.e. flowing blood as forbidden. For more details, see under heading (S-F-H).

“دِينَارٌ” (*deenar*) is the name of a gold coin. The plural is “دَنَانِيرٌ” (*dananeer*). It is a non-Arabic word that has been arabized. This was used by Arabs from the days of old, so it became Arabic {T}. The Quran has used this word in 3:74.

Some say that the word was actually “دِينَارٌ” (*dinar*). That is why its plural is “دَنَانِيرٌ” (*dananeer*) {T}. It means a pound, or guinea which is golden as well. It is a Roman word *Dinarins* which has been arabized. Roman coins were generally used by the Arabs. (See heading dirham).

“دَنَا” (*dun'a*), “يَدْنُو” (*yadnu*), “دُنُوَا” (*dunuwa*), “دَنَاوَةٌ” (*danawah*): to get closer.

“الدُّنْيَا” (*ad-dunyah*): the closest thing. The masculine form is “أَدْنَى” (*adna*).

“دُنَى” (*dun*), “يَدْنَى” (*yadna*) means to be old and weak.

“أَدْنَى الرَّجُلِ إِدْنَاءً” (*adnar rajulu idna*): that man lived a life of deprivation and poverty.
 “أَدْنَى الشَّيْءِ” (*adnash shaiya*): to bring something closer.
 “أَدْنَتْ تَوْبَهَا عَلَيَّهَا” (*adnati saubiha alaiha*) he covered himself with a cloth {L}.

33:59	They should cover themselves with their shawls.	لَّذِينَ عَلَيْهِنَ مِنْ جَلَابِيبٍ
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“أَدْنَى” (*aladna*) means closer. Sometimes it means small as “أَصْغَرُ” (*asghar*) and comes opposite to “أَكْبَرُ” (*akbar*) which means big. Sometimes it means bad or demeaning “أَرْذَلُ” (*arzal*) and comes opposite to “خَيْرُ” (*khair*) which means good. Sometimes it means first “أَوَّلُ” (*awwal*) and comes against “آخِرُ” (*aakhir*) which means last. Sometimes it means closer “أَقْرَبُ” (*aqrab*) and comes opposite to “أَقْصَى” (*aqsa*) which means far {T, R}.

The Quran says:

30:3	the land nearby	فِي أَدْنَى الْأَرْضِ
53:8-9	he again got close, or closer	ثُمَّ دَنَا-- أَوْ أَدْنَى
55:54	Close	دَانٍ
69:23	Close	فُطُوقُهَا دَانِيَةٌ
37:6 67:5	The nearest sky	السَّمَاءِ الدُّنْيَا

Also see heading (S-M-W).

“الدُّنْيَا” (*ad-duniya*) (closest) has come against “الْقُصْوَى” (*al-quswa*) (farthest) in 8:42. This word has been used against “أَكْبَرُ” (*akbar*) (big) in 32:21, against “أَكْثَرُ” (*aksar*) (most) in 58:7, against “خَيْرُ” (*khair*) (good) in 2:61.

The Quran has used “الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا” (*al-hverseid dunyah*) as against “آخِرَةُ” (*akhirah*), meaning the life of this world against the Hereafter. It has appeared at many places and this is the comparison which is most noteworthy, because in this comparison, life in this world “الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا” (*al-hverseid duniya*) has been declared very small or of less significance than the Hereafter “آخِرَةُ” (*akhirah*).

In religions in general, where the concept of soul and materialism exists, the world of *duniyah* and its possession have been termed very belittling and insignificant. According to the Hindu religion, the world is nothing but *maya* or deceit, and getting rid of this deceit is *mukti* or emancipation. According to the Buddhist religion, every wish is the precursor of some difficulty or ill. Therefore, real life, it says, is to give up any desire. This is shared by the Christians where the real kingdom is in the Heavens. As such for them, giving up the world is very acceptable. This is the very core of *tasawwuf* and some of our own Muslims have been influenced by this concept and the world or *duniya* is condemnable and little. Therefore, worldly and sinful have come to mean almost the same.

To the contrary, world or *duniya* and *deen* are said to be opposites. But this concept is against the teachings of the Quran. It teaches a *momin* to pray for “فِي بَدِهِ الدُّنْيَا حَسَنَةً” (*fi haazehid duniyah hasanah*) in 7:156 (i.e. wellbeing in his world), and says clearly:

16:30	The result of good deeds is not only the good things or pleasantness in the <i>aakhirah</i> (hereafter) but this world too	لِّلَّذِينَ أَحْسَنُوا فِي هَذِهِ الدُّنْيَا حَسَنَةٌ
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Against it, it terms:

7:156	Ignominy in this world, as God's wrath	ذِلَّةً فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا
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Such verses have appeared at different places in the Quran. As such this concept is *baatil* or untrue that this world and its luxuries and comforts are sinful.

But the Quran also contains certain verses which have termed the life of this world as transitory or impermanent and the life here as “لهو” (*lahu*) and “لعب” (*la'ab*). To understand this point, see under heading (*A-Kh-R*) and (*Ain-J-L*) in which it has been explained as to what is meant by “مَفَادٍ عَاجِلَةٍ” (*mufaadi aajila*) or immediate benefits) and “مَتَاعُ آخِرَةٍ” (*mata-i aakhirah*) or the wealth of the Hereafter. There you will find that the Quran strongly opposes those who have “مَفَادٍ عَاجِلَةٍ” (*muffadi aajila*) i.e. immediate benefits of this world in sight and ignore the pleasantness of the Hereafter. This temporary benefit has been called “مَتَاعُ الدُّنْيَا” (*mata-id duniya*) or immediate benefit, and condemns those strongly who ignore the lasting benefits of the Hereafter to choose the immediate benefits of this world. As such, according to Quran condemnable is for man to ignore the lasting benefits of the future in the Hereafter for immediate gains in this world. That is to consider real life only to be in this world, and it is also condemnable to give up this world and set about building the future. This is called monasticism which according to the Quran is not permissible. See under heading (*R-H-B*).

The Quran says:

2:201	The good things in this life as well the good things in the life hereafter. (Good immediate benefits as well as benefits in the future)	رَبَّنَا آتِنَا فِي الدُّنْيَا حَسَنَةً وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ حَسَنَةً
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It has also said that if the present of somebody is not good, then his future too is bleak:

17:72	he whoever is blind here (unseeing the truths) will be blind there too, or rather worse	وَمَنْ كَانَ فِي هَذِهِ أَعْمَىٰ فَهُوَ فِي الْآخِرَةِ أَعْمَىٰ وَأَضَلُّ سَبِيلًا
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For the meaning of “أَعْمَى” (*aama*) see under heading (*Ain-M-Y*).

As such:

- 1) The concept that this world's pleasant things are hateful is wrong
- 2) It is wrong too that only this life is everything, and only these world's benefits or gains should be kept in mind.
- 3) The right concept is that the gains of this life are also attained and human personality due to its capabilities becomes able to reap the benefits in the Hereafter too. Also not to concentrate only on personal benefits but keep an eye open for the betterment of the entire human race and coming generations too. This will be this life's future and the rest in the lie to come. (More details under heading (*A-Kh-R*)).

The entire teachings of the Quran are focused on establishing values for man. It tells him what the value of everything is in the scale of humanity. After that, it advises to sacrifice petty gains for greater gains. It tells us that no doubt the pleasant things of this life are indeed attractive and they should be attained or strived for, but when the interests of this life and the life hereafter clash, then the petty interests of this physical life must be sacrificed for the greater goal in the hereafter. These are the places where Quran has termed the interests of this world lowly as compared to those of the Hereafter. This in no way means that this life is hateful. This is the Quran's teaching about this world and the Hereafter.

D-H-R

د ه ر

“الدَّهْرُ” (*ad-dahr*) is the period from the beginning of this world till the end. Then it began to be mean a long period as against “زَمَانٌ” (*zaman*) which means both a short or long period {*R*}.

The Quran says:

76:1	that is, a period, or the duration of a period	حِينَ مِنَ الدَّهْرِ
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Ibn Faris says it means overpowering (or hold) or forcible.

Present time conditions are called “دَهْرٌ” (*dahr*) because it encompasses everything and has a hold over it.
 “الدَّهْرُ بَرٌّ” (*ad-dhariribrur*): the vicissitudes of time.
 “تَبَرُّهُمْ أَمْرٌ” (*daharahum amr*): some misfortune befell them {T}.

The Quran has recalled what some people say:

45:44	This is only the passage of time which causes our deaths.	وَمَا يُهْلِكُنَا إِلَّا الدَّهْرُ
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As time passes one's limbs weaken and deterioration ends in his death and life ends there. There is no other life after this. This is the very concept which in today's world is known as the materialistic concept of life.

The Quran says:

45:24	This concept is not based on knowledge.	وَمَا لَكُمْ بِذَلِكَ مِنْ عِلْمٍ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ إِلَّا تَظُنُّونَ
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This is only guess work and goes back fourteen hundreds years or so. In our time, the new concepts and philosophic and scientific that have been formulated, state that the reality of time is quite different. This is only the beginning of research on this very difficult and sensitive topic. Now research says that life continues onwards. The passage of time weakens human body indeed, but it does nothing to his personality. It is not affected by time.

According to the Quran, Man is not only the physical being, but his personality. If it is developed according to the dictates of the Quran, then death can have no effect on it and it moves ahead to cover the other stages of life. That is why “دَهْرٌ” (*dahr*) or time can not affect it.

The Quran has also termed the period when man had not even come into existence as “الدَّهْرُ” (*ad-dahr*).

76:1	There has been a time for man when he was not even a subject to be mentioned	عَلَّ أَنْتَى عَلَى الْإِنْسَانِ حِينَ مِّنَ الدَّهْرِ لَمْ يَكُن شَيْئًا مَّذْكُورًا
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But this does not mean that time itself is to be mistaken as God. However, the debate about time or “دَهْرٌ” (*dahr*) is very complex and is out of our purview. The Quran has used this word in the above meanings at two places only. At these places its meanings are very clear and distinct and simple, and to understand them no philosophical debate is required.

D-H-Q

د ه ق

“دَهَقَ الْكَاسَ” (*dahaqal kaas*): he filled the cup.
 “مَاءٌ دَبَاقٌ” (*ma un dehaaq*): abundant water.
 “كَاسٌ دَبَاقٌ” (*kaasun dihaaq*): clean cup, filled cup.
 “الدَّبِقُ” (*ad-dahq*): to press hard.
 “الدَّهَقُ” (*ad-dahaq*): vice.
 “الْمُدَّهَقُ” (*al-muddahaq*): that which is pressed hard {T}.
 “دَبَاقًا” (*dihaaq*): something stuffed, probably because something is filled in it by pressing hard.

The Quran says “كَأْسًا دَبَاقًا” (*kasan dihaqan*) in 78:34 that is, clean and full to the brim cup. That is, this is the particularity of a *jannati* (heavenly) society. The right life should be like this. Full and pure, which contains everything that increases life, purity and movement and everything is abundant and pure. In which aside from catering to his physical needs, his latent capabilities are fully developed and purity of heart and sight are also present. The cups of life are full of pure and strengthening pleasantness.

Ibn Faris says this also contains the element of spilling over or movement aside from being full to the brim.

”الْدُهْمَةُ“ (*ad-duhma*): blackness.

”إِدْبَامُ الشَّيْءِ“ (*idhaamash shaiyi*): the thing turned black.

”إِدْبَامُ الزَّرْعِ“ (*idhaamaz zar'ah*): due to being watered the field became blackish.

”حَدِيقَةُ دَهْمَاءٍ وَمُدْبَاهَةٍ“ (*hadeeqatun dahma-oo wa mud hammatah*): a green garden which seems blackish due to the vegetation. The Arabs also call dark green color as ”دُهْمَةٌ“ (*duhma*) because the color resembles black, while light black color is called ”خُضْرَةٌ“ (*khuzrah*) because it comes close to green {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris says it means to cover something in darkness. Later, due to much usage the condition of blackness or darkness was also removed. The Quran, due to the heavy vegetation in the gardens of *jannat* (heaven) have called it ”مُدْبَاهَتَيْنِ“ (*mud hammataan*) in 55:64. It also means a life which has reached the peak in freshness, flowering and delightfulness.

”الْدُهْنَةُ“ (*ad-duhna*): slipperiness, greasy.

”الْدُهْنُ“ (*ad-duhn*): oil.

”الْمُدْحُنُ“ (*ak-mudhun*): bottle of oil.

”إِدْحَنَ“ (*idhan*): he rubbed oil (on his body) {T, M, R}.

The Quran says about the olives:

23:20	It comes out with oil. (It has oil inside it).	تَنْبُتُ بِالذَّهْنِ
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Ibn Faris says it means softness, ease and shortage.

”اِبْنٌ“ (*ad-han*) means to misappropriate (from something which is kept in trust).

”الْمُدَاهِنَةُ“ (*al-mudaahana*): deceit, make believe, false, showy (as far as clever talk) is concerned.

”الْإِدْبَانُ“ (*al-idhaan*): to deceive, to be a hypocrite, to be soft, to concede, to be unserious and untruthful {T, M, R}.

Surah *Al-Qalam* says:

28:9	They want you to shift a little then they too will shift a little.	وَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْفٰدِحُونَ
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It means that they want to compromise their positions if you to do the same. But the person who is on right, by shifting embraces falsehood (*baatil*). Conversely, if *baatil* or falsehood shifts from its position, then it does not matter. It remains false.

Supposing *Zaid* says three plus three are six and *Bakar* says this is not so. Now an arbitrator tells one of them to move up a little and the other to move down a little so that three and three become five. *Bakar* stands to lose nothing because he was wrong the first time and would still be so. But *Zaid* will move from the truth to untruth or falsehood. This is the reason that *haqq* (truth) cannot move even a little from its position. It is fixed in its position. The established principles of this way of life do not have any capacity for any leeway.

In surah *Al-Waaqiah* at first it is said how great a book the Quran is and after that it is said in (56:81):

”أَفَبِهَذَا الْحَدِيثِ أَنْتُمْ مُدْبِهُونَ“ (*afabihaazal hadisi antoom mudhenoon*) can have two meanings.

One is, “do you make any changes in this book by your glib talk?”

Second is “do you use this book to move people away from the right path?”

The meaning of both is actually the same. Monasticism does indeed do this. It amends the teachings of the Quran and moves people away from the right path, and only because they want to make a living (out of monasticism).

56:82	You make this untruth the means of your earning?	وَجَعَلُونَ رِزْقَكُمْ أَنْتُمْ تُكَذِّبُونَ
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“الْدِّهَانُ” (*ad-dihaan*): red skin, or the dregs of oil {*T*}.

The Quran says that the sky will:

55:37	(The sky) will be torn asunder	وَرْدَةٌ كَالِدِّهَانِ
70:8	will become like molten metal	كَالْمُهْلِ

D-H-W/Y

د ه و ی

“دَاهَا” (*dahah*), “دَاهِيَا” (*dahya*): he picked holes in it, criticized it, hurt him a lot.
 “الدَّاهِيَةُ” (*ad-daahiyah*): great thing, great misfortune.
 “دَوَائِي الدَّيْرِ” (*dawahiya addahr*): the misfortunes or ills that time brings.
 “الدَّاهِي” (*ad-dahyo*), “الدَّهَاءُ” (*ad-dhaha*): surprising cleverness, fine opinion.
 “دَاهِيَا” (*dahiya*): he worked very cleverly {*T, M*}.
 “رَجُلٌ دَاهٍ” (*rajulun daahin*) means a very astute and clever person {*T, M*}. Most of the ills of this world are created due to the deceits created by people’s intellect.

The Quran says:

54:46	that moment of revolution will be extremely misfortune and will come surprisingly	وَالسَّاعَةُ أَدْهَى
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Ibn Faris says that “دَاهِي” (*dahyun*) means for something unpleasant to make its appearance, but it comes before man so suddenly and in such a way that man is awestruck. A revolution or is something which appears suddenly and surprises onlookers.

D-W-R

د و ر

“دَار” (*daar*), “يَدُور” (*yadura*), “دَوْرًا” (*daura*): to revolve.
 “الدَّوَّارَةُ” (*ad-dawarah*): compass.
 “الدَّائِرَةُ” (*ad-dairah*): circle. Plural is “دَوَائِرُ” (*dawa-ir*).
 “الدَّارُ” (*ad-daar*): house. Plural is “دِيَارُ” (*diyaar*), because people move around in it, or come back to the place they have left from. It also means neighborhood, city, area, a place to stay or residence, as well as the world, and also time which keeps moving.
 “دَارَةٌ” (*daarah*): cycle of misfortune.
 “الْمَدَارُ” (*al-madaar*): orbit {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says it means for one thing to surround another from all sides.

The Quran says:

9:98	Annihilation and destruction surrounded them from all sides. (Surrounded them like a circle,	عَلَيْهِمْ دَائِرَةُ السُّوءِ
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	encircled them).	
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Surah *At-Taubah* says:

9:98	They wait for you to be caught in trouble.	يَتَرْتَضُونَ بِكُمْ الدَّوَائِرَ
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In surah *An-Nooh* “دَيَّارًا” (*diyaara*) in 71:26 means resident, one who dwells. It is also used to mean any one after a negative {*T, M, R*}.

“دَارُ الْآخِرَةِ” (*daarul aakhirah*) in 2:94 has been used by the Quran several times as in 2:94. It means the house of the hereafter or the residence in the hereafter. That is, the life of the future and its comforts. See under heading (*A-Kh-R*).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says about trade “تُدِيرُونَهَا” (*tudeerunaha*) in 2:282, which you give and take. That is which you exchange mutually, move goods around.

D-W-L

د و ل

“الدَّالَّةُ” (*ad-dalah*): fame.

“الدَّوْلَةُ” (*ad-daulah*): turn.

“صَارَ الْفَيْءُ دَوْلَةً بَيْنَهُمَا” (*saaral fai'o daulatan bainahum*): the war booty was divided and began circulating {*T*}.

“دَاوَلَ” (*dawaal*): to turn away.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for one thing to move to another place.

The Quran says:

3:139	These are the conditions which we keep changing among men. (Sometimes it is one's turn, sometimes it is another's).	تِلْكَ الْأَيَّامُ نُدَاوِلُهَا بَيْنَ النَّاسِ
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“تَدَاوَلُوهُ” (*tadawalu*): they took it in turn {*T*}.

“دَوْلَةٌ” (*doolah*) and “دَوْلَةٌ” (*daulah*): some say they mean the same thing, that is, to revolve or move around, but others contend that “دَوْلَةٌ” (*daulah*) means for two armies to win in turn, that is, first one army is victorious then the defeated army overpowers the victorious one {*T*}.

“دَوْلَةٌ” (*doolah*) means the customs that keep changing. Some say it means something which keeps changing hands, while “دَوْلَةٌ” (*daulah*) is the change that takes place {*T*}.

About the revolving of wealth, the Quran has said:

59:7	so that it does keep changing hands only among the rich or wealthy	كَئِنْ لَا يَكُونُ دَوْلَةً بَيْنَ الْأَغْنِيَاءِ مِنْكُمْ
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This is a great economic principle which the Quran has related so simply. There is unease in the society due to wealth moving around only in the wealthy circles. According to the Quran, no one should possess extra wealth nor should wealth remain confined to certain circles. The government's money too should not only be spent among the wealthy circles. It should be spent for the common good.

D-W-M

د و م

“دَوَامٌ” (*dawaam*) means for something to stay as it is.

“دَامَ الشَّيْءُ” (*daamash shaiy'o*) means when a thing lasts for a long time {*T, R*}.

“الْمَاءُ الدَّائِمُ” (*al-maaud-dayim*): standing or stagnant water.
 “الْمَدَامُ” (*al-mudaam*): continuous rain.

Ibnul Aerabi says “دَامَ الشَّيْءُ” (*daamush shaiyi*) means the thing revolved or turned. This word is also used for getting tired or to stop.

“الدُّوَامَةُ” (*ad-duwamma*) is a top which kids use to spin.

Ibn Keesaan writes that in “مَادَامَ زَيْدٌ قَائِمًا” (*ma-dama zaid qaima*), ma means that when Zaid stands up, you do same {T, R}.

Surah *Ar-Ra'ad* says about the *jannat* (heaven), “أُكُلُهَا دَائِمٌ” (*ukuluha daayim*) in 13:35, its fruits will last (forever). That is, the gainful things of the heaven will be lasting, will never cease to exist, there will be no shortage of Sustenance.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:108	As long as the sky and earth remain in their present state. (for a very long time)	خَالِدِينَ فِيهَا مَا دَامَتِ السَّمُوتُ وَالْأَرْضُ
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For details see heading (*Kh-L-D*).

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says:

3:74	Except if you stand at his head. (Pester him by your presence).	إِلَّا مَا دُمْتُ عَلَيْهِ قَائِمًا
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D-W-N

د و ن

“دُونُ” (*doon*) is used for several meanings. As against “فَوْقُ” (*fauq*) or up, it means down.

“هُوَ دُونَهُ” (*huwa doonahu*): he is under him, below him. Sometimes it means near.

“زَيْدٌ دُونَكَ” (*zaidun doonak*): Zaid is near you (in stature etc.). It also means to be in front.

“مَشَى دُونَهُ” (*masha doonahu*): he led from the front, walked ahead of him. It also means being beyond as

“هُوَ أَمِيرٌ عَلَى مَا دُونِ جِيحُونِهِ” (*huwa ameerun ala ma doona jaihoon*): he is the *ameer* (head) of the area beyond *Jihoon*.

It is also used to mean ‘beside’.

“وَيَعْمَلُونَ عَمَلًا دُونِ ذَلِكَ” (*wa ya'malkoona amlun doona zaalik*): they do other things beside it.

Muheet says the word means the opposites, such as in front and in back, up and down etc.

“شَيْءٌ دُونٌ” (*shaiyun doon*): it means a lowly thing but it also means something respectable and good thing {T}.

“مِنْ دُونِ” (*min dooni*) means beside.

The Quran says:

72:11	Some of us who do good deeds and some are at a lower level.	وَ أَتَيْنَا الصَّالِحِينَ وَمِنَّا دُونُ ذَلِكَ
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To mean except or to mean first, this word has appeared in 33:21 where it is said:

33:21	We will make them taste the great punishment aside from or first, the smaller <i>azaab</i> (punishment).	وَلَنَذِقَنَّهُمْ مِنَ الْعَذَابِ الْأُولَى دُونُ الْعَذَابِ الْآخِرِ
3:37	Let not the <i>momins</i> make friends with other than <i>momins</i> . (not to be friendly with the deniers)	لَا يَتَّخِذِ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ الْكَافِرِينَ أَوْلِيَاءَ مِنْ دُونِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ

Likewise if the believers get friendly to the deniers then they too will be counted among them.

The Quran has used “مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ” (*min dooni-llah*) at several places. This phrase may mean that they worship others beside Allah, and also that they do not reach (or observe) the laws of Allah. Before reaching there, they believe on man’s self-made laws and *shariah* (way of life). There are many lords that man worships instead of Allah. These are not the gods of statues or idols but that of human emotions. These are gods of religious entities, the gods of powerful people, etc. These are the gods, which prevent man from reaching the only God and His laws.

Raghib says “دُونُ” (*doon*) is used when somebody is unable to reach something. Hence, “مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ” (*min dooni-llah*) would mean to worship other things even before being able to reach God.

After the revelation of the Quran, there is no question of not being able to reach God, because following the instructions in this Book, which is before everybody, is the means to reach Him.

D-Y-N

د ي ن

“دِينُ” (*deen*): this word is used for a lot of meanings as overpower, power, government, state, constitution, law and order, decision, solid result, reward and punishment, return etc. This word is also used for obedience and faithfulness {T}.

Lataif-ul-Lugha too says it means accountability, overpower, habit etc.
Kitaab-ul-Ashqaq says it means obedience, way “دَابُّ” (*daa-b*) and nation.

The Quran has used the word in all these meanings.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says:

2:13	I have submitted myself to the Lord of the Worlds	أَسْلَمْتُ لِرَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ
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To bow the head before the universal Sustainer has been called “الْدِّينُ” (*ad-deen*) in 2:131, 2:132. It has been called “الْإِسْلَامُ” (*al-islam*) in 3:18.

The Quran says:

56:86	86 those who are not under anybody	غَيْرِ مَدِينٍ
9:29	they do not follow the law of God	وَلَا يَدِينُونَ دِينَ الْحَقِّ
12:76	the law of the authority holder	دِينَ الْمَلِكِ
24:2	God’s law or the law of the government	دِينَ اللَّهِ
9:36	That is the law of stability	ذَلِكَ الدِّينُ الْقَيِّمُ
24:25	In that period, Allah’s shall give them their justified way of truth	يَوْمَئِذٍ يُوفِّيهِمُ اللَّهُ دِينَهُمُ الْحَقَّ

As you see in 9:36, when surah **At-tauba** talks about the twelve months on which 4 are of prohibition, there too the word of “دِينُ” (*deen*) has been used for laws and authority. But in 24:25 “دِينُ” (*deen*) means the term or results of ones deeds.

“دِينُ” (*deen*) means the return or result of the deeds (that is, reward or punishment).

Ibn Qateebah says that it may also mean accountability. {*Ibn Qateebah - Al-qartai vol. 1 page 4*}

Surah **As-Saffaat** says:

37:53	Will We be accountable for your deeds? Will We get the return for your deeds?	ءَاِنَّا لَمَدِينُونَ
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The Quran has made the meaning of “يَوْمُ الدِّينِ” (*yaumud deen*) clear by asking “مَا أَذْرَاكَ مَايَوْمُ الدِّينِ” (*adraaka yaumud deen*) Do you know what the Day of the **Deen** is?

And proceeded to answer it as “يَوْمٌ لَا تَمْلِكُ نَفْسٌ لِّنَفْسٍ شَيْئًا وَالْأَمْرُ يَوْمَئِذٍ لِلَّهِ” (*yauma la tamliku nafsun linafsin shaiyan wal amru yaumaiznillah*) in 82:18-19. During which time no man will hold any power or right.

In surah *Al-Fateha*, it is said:

1:3	Time during which human life will be spent according to the law of Allah	مَلِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ
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The basic characteristic of such a life will be that no man will be superior to any other. The only authority will be that of Allah. This is a great freedom which man will enjoy under Allah’s laws.

“دِينٌ” (*deen*) also means habit, as well as the rain which habitually comes down in one place {T}. This meaning too holds the connotation of a sort of rule. Allah’s laws are called the laws of nature in the universe, while in human world Allah’s laws are received (by the messengers) through the revelation. This law is safe in the Quran in its completed and unalterable form. It is called “الدِّينُ” (*ad-deen*), and to act according to it is called “الإسلام” (*al-islam*).

The fact is that in this world many different terms are used such as social system, rule of life, laws of government, constitution of the state etc. But the Quran has used one composite term instead of them all, and that is “الدِّينُ” (*ad-deen*). This is our social system, the rule or order of our lives, the law of our government and the constitution of our state. According to this constitution, only Allah can determine the limits of man permanently. Nobody else has this right, and Hence, in this way of life, the sovereignty belongs only to Allah. This sovereignty of His is exercised through the Quran. Therefore, practically speaking, sovereignty belongs to Allah’s Book (the Quran) in this world. The Islamic government is only the means through which Quranic principles are implemented in this world, and since the criteria for man’s deeds to be right or wrong is also this Book. Therefore, reward and punishment is also according to it. This brings Islamic justice in focus which means not only court justice but justice in all aspects of life. The constitution of an Islamic state is in other words the unalterable rules of the Quran. All matters of this Islamic state take place within the parameters of these rules. The purpose is to maintain a system of balance and justice. This is what **DEEN** is.

As such, *deen* would mean the God given system of life which determines the limits of our freedom and according to which our deeds are judged. In the era in which men become followers of this system, they will be free of all hegemony and only be subservient to Allah’s laws, because the Lord of the period of **Deen** is no one else but Allah. Every decision in that period will be according to the laws of Allah, will be a *deeni* (according to the *deen*) decision and will be based on the norms of Quranic justice.

In surah *Al-Fateha*, along with the attributes of Allah of being the Sustainer, His system of justice has also been mentioned (*maaliki yaumiddeen* – the Lord of the Day of Judgment). It means that Allah has granted the accoutrements of life to man without any effort, but the determination of his stages will be according to his deeds. It is called a life according to Allah’s law and justice, and this is what distinguishes man from animals.

About *Al-Medina*, some think that this word has come from the word *this* way of life meaning law and order. Since *Medina* is the central place from which law and order is controlled, some also think that it has come as a follow up of the word meaning obedience or following. Because in the city of *Medina* one has to be obey the law {T}.

Kitaab ul-Ashfaq says that this word was derived from *Deen* and was originally *madinah*.

Ibn Faris says *deen basically has the connotation of obedience and the city is called Medina because the government in that city is obeyed.*

“دَيْنٌ” (*dain*): a loan because a borrower has to bend before the lender.

“تَدَايُنٌ” (*tadayun*): to deal in loan mutually, as in 2:282.

“دَيْنٌ” (*dain*) is that loan which has a time frame for repayment. The loan which has no time frame for repayment is not “دَيْنٌ” (*dain*) but called “قَرْضٌ” (*qarz*) {*T*}.

Muheet, with the agreement of **Taj** says commonly “دَيْنٌ” (*dain*) is a loan which is given for a fixed period on interest, but since the Quran has forbidden interest, as such for mutual loans among **muslims**, the word loan is for interest free loans only (2:282).

As said earlier, the Quran has used the word several times and it means the order of life.

3:19	The way of life which is close to Allah, is al-Islam	إِنَّ الدِّينَ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ الْإِسْلَامُ
5:3	And I have approved for you al-Islam as your way of life	وَرَضِيتُ لَكُمُ الْإِسْلَامَ دِينًا
9:33	He is the one who have sent His messengers with guidance and this way of life of truth to manifest it over all other systems of life.	هُوَ الَّذِي أَرْسَلَ رَسُولَهُ بِالْهُدَىٰ وَدِينِ الْحَقِّ لِيُظَاهِرَهُ عَلَى الدِّينِ كُلِّهِ

Also see 38:28

This is the **Deen** with which the Messenger (pbuh) was endowed. God is the one who sent His Messenger with the **deen of truth (deen-al-haqq)** so that he may implements it (system of life) over all the prevailing systems, no matter how abhorring it may be for the **mushrikeen** (those who follow other systems).

The word **mazhab** or religion has not been used even once by the Quran, Therefore, the word **mazhab** or religion must not be taken for **deen-e-Islam**. **Mazhab** is the way of life that has been designed by man, while **Deen** is the system which has come from God. This is the reason that there are many sects in religion whereas **Deen** considers sectarianism as '**shirk**' which is the greatest of sins (30:32). The **Deen** given by God is the same for everyone and there is no question of any sect in it. Sects are created by man by following different paths of life. God's **Deen** came to earlier dynasties of man (through the prophets) but they destroyed their celestial Books and instead adopted the ways of life created by men. Thus, they lost the **Deen** which was replaced by Religions.

But in the Quran, God has made the **Deen** secure in its original form. This **Deen** was the constitution of the state that was later created by the Messenger **Mohammed** (pbuh). We sidetracked the Book of God and started following the teachings given by man. Thus, we too, adopted religion in place of **Deen**. We are like the earlier nations in this respect, but we are still different in a way. They do not have the God given **Deen** in its original form and cannot replace their religions with the **Deen**. But we do have the Book of God in its real form. Therefore, we can replace our religion with the original **Deen** of Allah at any time we want (similarly other nations too, if they want, can adopt the God given **Deen** in the Quran). Until we do so, we cannot reach life's destiny.

“ذَا” (za): this. The feminine is “ذِهِ” (zih). “ذِهِ” (zih), “ذِهِ” (zihi), “ذِهِ” (zihee): up to. For two it is “ذَانِ” (zaan) or “ذَيْنِ” (zain). For feminine it is “تَانِ” (taan), “تَيْنِ” (tain). And plural is “أُولَاءِ” (oolaa-i) which is generally preceded by “هَـ” (ha) as “هَـذَا” (haaza) for masculine and “هَـذِهِ” (haazehi) for feminine. This pontification is for a near thing. For a distant pontification, it is “ذَلِكَ” (zaalika) with feminine “تِلْكَ” (tilka). If we are addressing a man we will say see that thing or “ذَلِكَ” (zaalika). If we are addressing two men we will say “ذَٰلِكُمَا” (zaalikuma). If there are many men, we will say, “ذَٰلِكُمْ” (zaalikum). If the addressee is a woman, we will say “ذَٰلِکَ” (zaaliki), and many women as “ذَٰلِکُنَّ” (zaalikun).

“ذَا” (za) has different uses. For instance:

2:255	Who can dare stand with anyone in his place (who can dare to support anyone in His kingdom).	مَنْ ذَٰلِذِی یَشْفَعُ عِنْدَهُ--
2:219	They ask you what should be kept open (available).	یَسْأَلُونَکَ مَاذَا یُنْفِقُونَ--
20:63	They are merely sorcerers	إِنَّ هَٰذِهِ لَسَاحِرَاز--
2:2	This is the book	ذَٰلِکَ الْکِتَاب--
2:141	This was a group or party which has passed away.	تِلْکَ أُمَّةٌ قَدْ خَلَتْ
28:32	These two are clear reasoning (signs).	فَٰذَٰلِکَ بُرْهَانَانِ--

As said earlier, “ذَٰلِکَ” (zaalika) is used for pointing at a distant thing as well as a near thing.

Surah *Ar-Room* says:

30:30	With the nature of Allah's laws that He has created for mankind. There can not be any change in what Allah's law creates	فُطِرَتِ اللّٰهُ الَّتِیْ فَطَرَ النَّاسَ عَلَیْهَا لَا تَبْدِیلَ لِحُکْمِ اللّٰهِ
30:30	This is the lasting <i>deen</i>	ذَٰلِکَ الدِّیْنُ الْقَیِّمُ

Or in surah *Bani Israel*:

17:35	this is in the end very good	ذَٰلِکَ خَیْرٌ وَأَحْسَنُ تَأْوِیْلًا
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At all these places “ذَٰلِکَ” (zalika) is for pointing to a near thing i.e. “this”.

As against this in the tale about *Moosa*, it is said:

18:64	that was the place we were looking for	ذَٰلِکَ مَا کُنَّا نَعِیْجُ
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Here “ذَٰلِکَ” (zaalik) is for pointing at a distant thing i.e. “that”.

Raghib says “ذَٰلِکَ” (zalik) is indeed used for a distant thing but that is not the only thing meant by it. It is also used for anything which is on a higher plane and Thus, distant. No matter if that thing is physically near. So “ذَٰلِکَ الْکِتَابُ لَارِیْبَ فِیْهِ” (zalika la raiba feeh) in 2:2 would mean “*this book, about which there is no uncertainty*”.

This name has been used by the Quran in respect of a messenger (21:85, 38:48), but he has not been mentioned besides these verses. He is probably the messenger *Ezekiel* who has been mentioned in the *Torah*. Also see under heading (K-F-L).

It is the nick name of Messenger **Yunus** who probably is the same as Jonah in **Torah** (21:87). For details see headings '**Yunus**' and '**Noon**'.

Dhaab

ذ أ ب

“الذَّئْبُ” (**az-zeib**): wolf, as in (12:13).

“الذَّأْبُ” (**az-zaab**): to frighten, to condemn, using harsh voice {**T**}, to use impolite talk.

“ذَأَبَ الرَّجُلُ” (**zaabar rajul**): the man shouted loudly {**M**}.

Ibn Faris has said that it means transition, unease.

It also means a moment of a thing which is from no particular direction.

“تَذَابَّتِ الرِّيحُ” (**tazabbatir reehu**): the breeze came from all sides.

A wolf is called “ذَيْبٌ” (**zeib**) because it sometime approaches from one side sometimes from the other.

Dh-A-M

ذ أ م

“يَذَامُهُ” (**yazaamuh**) “ذَامَهُ” (**zamah**): to consider somebody lowly or condemnable. It also means to accuse, or defame, or to harshly tell someone to get out {**T**, **M**}.

Raghib says it means condemnable.

“أَذَاوَمَ” (**azaamah**): Frightened and awed him {**T**, **M**}.

The Quran says about the **Iblees**.

7:18	Told insulted and belittled (or harshly) to get out.	قَالَ أَخْرِجْ مِنْهَا مَذْذُومًا مَذْخُورًا
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Dh-B-B

ذ ب ب

“ذُبَابٌ” (**zabaab**): flies. Singular is “ذُبَابَةٌ” (**zubaba**).

Muheet says with reference to **Jaahiz** that in addition to all kinds of common flies “ذُبَابٌ” (**zubaab**) covers bees and mosquitoes {**M**}.

The Quran has said:

22:73	they will not be able to create even a fly	لَنْ يَخْلُقُوا ذُبَابًا
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Flies are called “ذُبَابٌ” (**zubaab**) because they are driven away, or because they are never at rest in one place. This root contains both connotations.

Ibn Faris says the root basically means unease and movement.

Raghib says that “الذَّبْبَةُ” (*az-zab-zaba*) means the sound of something that is hanging. Then this word began to be used for every movement and unease (that is fluctuation and uncertainty) {*R*}.

“بَعِيرٌ ذَابٌ” (*bayeerun zaab*): a camel which does not stay in one place {*T*}.

“ذَبَابَةٌ” (*zab-zabah*): This word should perhaps be under heading Dh-B-Dh-B, but many linguists have placed it under Dh-B-B. Because of its meaning of being a share of something, we have also included it under this heading.

The Quran says about the *munafiqeen* (the hypocrites):

4:143	Wavering between that	مُذَبِّذِينَ بَيْنَ ذَلِكَ
4:143	neither wholly on this side nor wholly on that side	لَا إِلَى هُوءٍ لَا إِلَى هُوءٍ لَا

It is these very people about whom it is said:

22:11	who sit on the fence and observe the laws of Allah	مَنْ يَعْْبُدُ اللَّهَ عَلَى حَرْفٍ
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If gains are received on this side, they lean here, and if gains are perceived on the other side, then they lean towards it. Like a fly, nobody can predict where it will go next.

41:30	Once they accept God as the <i>Rabb</i> (Sustainer) then they stick to it.	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ قَالُوا رَبُّنَا اللَّهُ ثُمَّ اسْتَقَامُوا
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Belief and stability are the hallmark of a *momin* (peace maker). As against a hypocrite who is opportunist.

Dh-B-H ذ ب ح

“ذَبَحَ” (*zabah*), “يَذْبَحُ” (*yazbah*): to slaughter, to split, to tear apart {*T*}.

Ibn Faris also says that these are its basic meanings.

“ذَبَحَتْهُ الْعَبْرَةُ” (*zabahatul abrah*): tears choked him.

“الذَّبْبُحُ” (*at-tazbeeh*): to slaughter deeply, to bend the head so much that it gets lower than the waist.

“الذَّبْحُ” (*az-zibh*): the thing that is slaughtered {*T*}.

The Quran says about *Bani Israel* that:

2:49	(the people of the Pharaoh) killed your sons (<i>ibna</i>) and kept your daughters (<i>nisa</i>) alive.	يَذْبَحُونَ أَبْنَاءَكُمْ وَيَسْتَحْيُونَ نِسَاءَكُمْ
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This is generally taken to mean that the *Pharaoh* had ordered to kill every son that was born and to keep the baby girls alive. The question to ponder is whether “يَذْبَحُونَ” (*yuzabbihooona*) means actually to slaughter or something else.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* has used “يَقْتُلُونَ” (*yuqteloona*) instead of “يَذْبَحُونَ” (*yuzabboon*) in 7:149. Here it says that they used to kill your sons and kept your daughters alive. It is Therefore, clear that the Quran has used “ذَبَحَ” (*zabah*) and “قَتَلَ” (*qatal*) in similar meaning.

It has to be seen what “قَتَلَ” (*qatal*) means. This word has been debated in detail under the heading (Q-T-L). There you will see that it means not only to kill, but also to weaken or demean or make ineffective. It means to make something so ineffective that its presence or absence is made the same. It means to belittle somebody. It also means to deprive someone of knowledge and training. See these meanings under heading (Q-T-L). It is thought that here “قَتَلَ” (*qatal*) means not to kill (the sons of *Bani Israeel*), but to weaken them, demean them or make them ineffective.

The arguments against the notion that it really means “to kill” are as following.

- 1) In the time of **Moosa**, the nation of **Bani Israel** was huge. If the male kids in any society are killed and only the females are allowed to live, then after a time the nation will cease to exist. *
- 2) **Moosa**’s elder brother **Haroon** was alive and present and **Moosa** too was not killed immediately after birth. This also shows that the boys of the **Bani Israel** nation were not killed immediately after birth
- 3) Surah **Yunus** says in 10:83 that the youth of **Moosa**’s nation believed in him. See under heading (Z-R-R). If the boys of the **Bani Israel** were killed immediately after birth then this youth would not exist.
- 4) When **Moosa** came to the **Pharaoh**, he said, we have nurtured you and were your benefactors and you are repaying us Thus,. In reply **Moosa** said: “you remind me of the benevolence but you have enslaved the nation of Bani Israel (26:22)”. Here **Moosa** has accused the pharaoh of enslaving the nation of **Bani Israel**. If he had also ordered killing of new born boys of that nation, **Moosa** would have certainly accused the Pharaoh of this deed first. Because killing children was a much more severe crime than enslaving. But, nowhere in the Quran has **Moosa** accused the Pharaoh of so doing.

* Some books claim that Pharaoh killed 90.000 children of Bani Israel.

These facts show that the Pharaoh and his ilk did not kill the boys of the Bani Israel. It may be argued if this was not the case then why did **Moosa**’s mother leave him to drift in the river in a box? First, bear in mind that the Pharaoh is said to have ordered killing of new born males at the time when **Moosa** had come with his revolutionary message. (As long as the right meanings of these verses are not made clear, we will continue with the traditional meaning i.e. to kill the children of the Bani Israel.)

Surah **Al-Airaaf** says, that seeing the effectiveness of **Moosa**’s message, the leaders in the Pharaoh’s nation asked the Pharaoh why no harsh measures were taken against him? Why was he left free to do as he wanted? In reply the Pharaoh said he had a plan! And that is: “we will murder their boys and let the girls live” (7:127). From this it can be seen that this was said when **Moosa**’s message spread. This order did not prevail at the time of **Moosa**’s birth. Surah **Al-momin** makes this clearer where it is said that when **Moosa** went to the Pharaoh with the message of God, he said: “those who trust in **Moosa**’s God, kill their sons and let their women live” (40:25). Thus, it is clear that this order was issued at the time when **Moosa** came with the message, and not at his birth. Besides, this order was not for the entire Bani Israel nation but only for those who entrusted themselves to **Moosa**, or his God.

These facts show that at the time of **Moosa**’s birth, this order was not in force. When this order was not in force then it is not right to believe that God wanted to keep him alive in this manner. Why was then **Moosa** set out to drift in the river? The Quran has answered this question. The **Bani Israel** had entered Egypt in the time of Yusuf who gained an exalted position in Egypt. This respect would have reflected positively on his nation, the Bani Israel, and would have lasted some time even after Yusuf. But **Bani Israel** were later enslaved by the rulers. Even today, subjugated nations are worth almost nothing but in those days subjugated nations were almost like slaves. According to God’s plan, **Moosa** was born to oppose the Pharaohs. For this purpose, he needed to be educated and trained at a high level. For this aim, it was destined that he grows up at the Pharaoh’s palace itself. He should spend the early years as the Pharaoh’s adopted son. This was the reason that he was set to drift and land at the Pharaoh’s palace. The Quran says this was done so that he could be brought up under our watch (20:39). This meant good training from which the children of Bani Israel were barred. This was a link to the program and **Moosa** was being readied for this campaign. A little further, it is said “in this manner, O **Moosa**, you came up to Our standards” (20:41).

It will be related further ahead that those who had belief in **Moosa**’s God were spared by the Pharaoh, then why did he order killing of the new born babies? What was their fault?

Surah **Al-Qasas** says that **Moosa**’s mother was told to:

28:7	keep feeding him, and when you fear for him, then put him in the river	أَرْضِعِيهِ فَإِذَا خِفْتِ عَلَيْهِ فَأَلْقِيهِ فِي الْيَمِّ
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This is taken to mean that the Pharaoh had ordered the killing of male children. But Quranic evidence is there to refute this line of thinking because the Pharaoh's order came when **Moosa** was a grown man and had brought Allah's message. We have to attribute some other cause for this fear. Further ahead it is said that when Pharaoh's people found the box (with **Moosa** in it in his infancy), the pharaoh's wife said "do not kill him, we shall adopt him" (28:9). This too is taken to mean that in those days, Israeli kids were killed. But this is not a right guess because how was it known that the baby that had been rescued from the waves, was an Israeli kid and not a kid from among the Pharaoh's nation?

As such "لَا تَقْتُلُوهُ" (*la tuq tulu*) in 28:9 would not mean "do not kill him", but "do not throw him out as an insignificant being". See heading Q-T-L.

So what is the right meaning of "يَذَبُّونَ أَبْنَاءَ بُم وَيَسْتَحْيُونَ نِسَاءَ بُم" (*yuzabb-oona abna'ahum wa yastahyoona nisa'ahum*)?

We have seen that this was during the time that **Moosa's** message was spreading and the Pharaoh perceived this as a threat to his dominance. In addition when his advisers had asked him why nothing was being done about it, he had replied that he had a plan (7:127), and this was the plan (to perform *qatal* of *ibna*). The Quran has termed this scheme as "كَيْدٌ" (*kaidun*) in 40:25 which means a deep conspiracy.

About the Pharaoh, surah **Al-Qasas** says:

28:4	he used to divide and rule	وَجَعَلَ أَهْلَهَا شِيَعًا يَسْتَضَعِفُ طَائِفَةٌ مِّنْهُمْ
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Later it is said:

28:4	He used to <i>yuzabbuh</i> (tear apart) their <i>ibna</i> (strength), and let the <i>nisa</i> (weak) to be <i>yastahi</i> (live).	يَذَبُّحُ أَبْنَاءَهُمْ وَيَسْتَحْيِي نِسَاءَهُمْ
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He wanted to divide the nation of Israel into different parties so that they would be busy in struggling against each other. Every ruling nation indulges in this kind of conspiracy. Later after dividing them into parties he used to subjugate the party which he perceived was a strong threat to his rule. He used to humiliate and demean them, while he used to elevate the foppish or weak people. This too is practiced by every conquering nation. A dictator nation always keeps the subordinated nation divided. The strong section is always ridiculed and demeaned, while the weak and insignificant portion which they fear no danger from, get promoted.

The Quran has defined the strong and brave portion of a nation as "أَبْنَاءُ" (*ibna*) and the weak portion of a nation as "نِسَاءُ" (*nisa*). Hence, by "قَتْلُ أَبْنَاءُ" (*qatl-ibna*) the Quran means demeaning of the strong and brave section of a nation, while "وَيَسْتَحْيِي نِسَاءَهُمْ" (*yastahyai nisa'akum*) means to elevate weak section of a nation. In this way, he was weakening the **Bani Israel's** entire nation. The Quranic evidence points to this that *qatal* or *zabab* of *ibna'a* means this.

But this is only an assumption and can be given more thought. One can understand what the Pharaoh's order to kill the sons of those who believed in **Moosa** means (40:25). That is, his plan was to divide the entire Bani Israel into different parties so that those who were a threat to him could be made ineffective so that nobody listened to them. See this meaning of *qatal* under heading (Q-T-L). Otherwise, it is not reasonable to kill the sons of those who believe in Moses (and spare the believers themselves). In addition, this is a fact too that when the sorcerers of his court said that they had started believing (in **Moosa's** God), he ordered them to be hanged, not to kill their sons.

This shows that the phrase "ذَبْحُ أَبْنَاءُ" (*zabhi abna'akum*) and "إِسْتَحْيَاءُ نِسَاءُ" (*istahya'i nisa'akum*) has been used as a metaphor. This does not mean actually to slaughter them.

But as said earlier, this is an educated guess. If this reasoning is considered weak then “ذَبْحُ أَبْنَاءَ” (*zabha abna'a*) will be taken to mean what its literal meaning is i.e. the Pharaoh used to kill the boys of *Bani Israel* but up till now the history of ancient Egypt mentions no such murder or killing. Perhaps history may yet reveal such incidents. Up till now the *Torah* relates that the Pharaoh had ordered the killing of *Bani Israel's* boys (*Kitaab Khurooj*). But we all know historically how correct the *Torah* is.

In surah *Al-Ma'idah* the animals which were sacrificed on the altar of statues (gods) were called “مَذْبُحٌ عَلَى النُّصْبِ” (*ma zubha alan nusub*) in 5:3.

Surah *As-Saffaat* says that when *Ibrahim* got ready to sacrifice his son, and his son Ismail became ready to be sacrificed, then We called out to him to desist and “فَدَيْنَهُ بِذَبْحٍ عَظِيمٍ” (*wafadainahu bizibhin azeem*) (37:107): saved Ismail in exchange for a great sacrifice.

As is evident from various places in the Quran, this “بِذَبْحٍ عَظِيمٍ” (*zibhi azeem*) (great sacrifice) was that instead of the ruler ship of the green area of Syria, he was chosen for the caretaking of Kaba in the desolate land of Arabia. This was a lifelong sacrifice, not only for his own whole life, but also for the coming generations.

37:108	And We left for him among the later folk	وَتَرَكْنَا عَلَيْهِ فِي الْآخِرِينَ
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(For more details see my book *Jooye Noor* and the matters about the Bani Israel in my book *Barq-e-Toor*).

Dh-Kh-R ذ خ ر

“ذَخَرَ” (*zakhar*), “يَذْخُرُ” (*yazkhar*): to take something, to make it one's own, to hide something so that it may be used when required.

Ibn Faris says to keep something hidden for its safety.

“إِذْخَرَ” (*ad-zakhara*), “إِذْخَارٌ” (*id-zikhaar*): also means the same as “ذَخَرَ” (*zakhar*).

“إِذْخَارٌ” (*izkhaar*) was actually “إِذْخَارٌ” (*id-zikhaar*).

“الْمُذْخِرُ” (*al-muzakhir*): a horse who does not use all of his strength in running but preserves some {T}.

“الذَّاهِرُ” (*ad-zakhir*): plump, fat. {M}

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:49	And what you hoard in your houses	وَمَا تَدَّخِرُونَ فِي بُيُوتِكُمْ
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It seems that Jesus (since he had come with a true revolutionary message) was averse to the hoarding habit of the Jews. This is a pontification of that.

Dh-R-A ذ ر أ

“ذَرَأَ الْأَرْضَ” (*zaral ard*): sowed the seed (in the ground) {T}.

“ذَرَأَ اللَّهُ الْخَلْقَ” (*zara allah-ul-khalq*): Allah created the creatures and increased them, made it abundant.

The Quran says:

42:11	He keeps increasing you and spread you	يَذْرُؤُكُمْ فِيهِ
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Surah *Al-mominon* says:

23:79	He is the One who increased you and spread you on this on this earth.	هُوَ الَّذِي ذَرَأَكُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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Some think that “ذُرِّيَّةٌ” (*zurriyyah*) has come from “ذَرَأَ” (*zara*) but others say it has come from “ذَرَّ” (*zarr*) that we have mentioned under (*Dh-R-R*).

ذ ر ر Dh-R-R

“الذَّرُّ” (*az-zarr*): very small ants. The specks (dust) particles we see in the sunlight. The singular is “ذَرَّةٌ” (*az-zarru*). A very small and light thing is also called “ذَرَّةٌ” (*zarrah*).
“ذَرَّ” (*zarr*): to sprinkle something, to disburse or differentiate.

Surah *Al-zalzalah* says:

99:6	And whose doeth good an atom's weight	مَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ
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Ibn Faris says it means finesse and spreading.

“ذَرَّ الْمَلْحَ عَلَى اللَّحْمِ” (*zarral milha alal lahm*): He sprinkled the meat with salt.
“ذَرَّ الْحَبَّ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*zarral hubba fil ard*): He sprinkled the seeds in the ground {T}.
“الذَّرْبَةُ” (*az-zuriyyah*): a man's progeny whether male or female. Sometimes it is also used for one's parents and grandparents. This word sometimes means the opposites {T}. (We will read more about it further ahead).

Raghib says it actually means young children but sometimes it also means both young and older children, and is used as plural as well as singular. Some say the root of this word is “ذُرِّيَّةٌ” (*zara*) which means to create and increase {L}.

“ذَرَّ الْبَقْلُ” (*zarral baql*): the vegetable budded.

The Quran has used the word “ذُرِّيَّةٌ” (*zurriyah*) to mean descendants or generation (2:124).

Surah *Yasin* says:

36:41	And We bear their offspring in the laden ship	إِنَّا حَمَلْنَا ذُرِّيَّتَهُمْ فِي الْفُلِكِ
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Here “الذَّرِيَّةُ” (*zurriyah*) means all, big and small. Because of this verse (36:41), some attribute the meaning of progeny and grandparents to the word “الذَّرِيَّةُ” (*zurriyah*), and this is why it has been accepted to mean the opposites. But research shows that the Quran has never used this word for grandparents, but only for descendants (6:88).

Verse 36:41 also clarifies the meaning if we take “الْفُلُكُ الْمَشْحُونُ” (*al-foolkil mash hoon*) as the arc of *Nouh* which was built according to the revelation and “ذُرِّيَّةٌ” (*zurriyah*) to mean the young generation of humans of that time. This will leave no ambiguity in the meanings of the verse.

Surah *Yunus* says:

10:83	So nobody believed <i>Moosa</i> except the youth of his nation	فَمَا مَنِ الْمُؤْسَى الْأُدْرِيَّةُ مِنْ قَوْمِهِ
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Some say it means very small number of people {*Ibn Abbas*}. Others say it means the youth of that nation {*Abul Kalam Azad*}. We think the second meaning is clearer. The youth accept a revolutionary program more readily. The older people are more dogmatic about their previous dogmas. Also, due to the age factor, they have little capacity for adopting new things. It is the youth that accept a revolutionary program which is against oppressiveness without any fear. Also see under heading (*Dh-B-H*).

“الذراع” (*az-zara’a*): the part of the arm from the elbow to the end of the middle finger. It is also used to mean the wrist, and also a measure $\{T\}$.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:18	Their dog had both forelegs on the ground	وَكَلْبُهُمْ بَاسِطٌ ذِرَاعَيْهِ
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“ذراع كذا” (*zarohu kaza*): it is of such length $\{M\}$.

69:32	it is seventy hands long	ذُرْعُهَا سَبْعُونَ ذِرَاعاً
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Ibn Faris says it basically means to be long and move forward.

“مالي به ذراع” (*maali bi zarun*): I do not have recourse to it $\{T\}$.

“ضقت به ذراعاً” (*zdiqtu bi zar’a*): to have no capacity for doing something.

Surah **Hood** says about Loot:

11:77	In their matter, he found himself in capable	ضَاقَ بِهِمْ ذُرْعًا
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“الذَّرِيعَةُ” (*az-zuriyah*): the she-camel which is used as a shield while hunting {*T*}. It means any means which is used to reach the goal.

Dh-R-W ذ ر و

“ذَرَّتِ الرِّيحُ الشَّيْءَ وَرَوًّا” (*zaratir-raehoosh-shaiya warwa*): the wind blew it away.

“ذَرَا الحِنْطَةِ يَذْرُوبًا ذَرَوًّا” (*zaralhintata yazruha zarwa*): he threw the wheat in the air to separate it from the chaff.

“فَتَذَرَّتْ” (*fatazarrat*): the wheat became free of the chaff.

“ذُرَاوَةُ النَّبْتِ” (*zarawatun nabt*): the dry parts of a plant which fall away and are blown away by the wind.

“ذُرْوَةُ الشَّيْءِ” (*zurwatush shaiyi*): the higher part of a thing {*T*}.

Surah **Al-Kaif** says:

18:45	... the winds blow it around	تَذْرُوهُ الرِّيحُ
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Surah **Az-Zarriyat** says:

51:1	By those scattering, dispersing ...	وَالَّذِينَ ذَرَوْا
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“ذَرَوْ” (*zaru*) means to disperse, spread around.

“ذَارٍ” (*zaar*), “الذَّارِي” (*az-zaari*): one who spreads, one who disseminates, the forces which are the means of dissemination, the force which spreads the word around in the world, the means of communication and dissemination (media).

Dh-Ain-N ذ ع ن

“أَذْعَنَ” (*az'an*): to be quick in obedience, in following, to obey a command with alacrity.

“نَاقَةً مَّدْعَانٍ” (*naaqatun miz'an*): an obedient camel.

“مُدْعِنِينَ” (*mud'ineen*): those who became followers or obedient quickly (22:49) {*T*}.

“أَذْعَنَ لَهُ” (*az'ana lahu*): bowed before him and became obedient to him {*T*}.

Muheet while quoting the literal meaning of “الْإِذْعَانُ” (*al-iz'an*) says it means heartfelt intent and solidity after deliberation or hesitation.

“الْإِذْعَانُ” (*a-liz'an*) has different stages and the lowest is called opinion and the best is called **Iman** (trust/conviction), and between these two is the stage of mere custom and tradition {*T, L*}.

Dh-Q-N ذ ق ن

“الذَّقْنَ” (*az-zaqan*): chin {*T*}. Plural is “أَذْقَانُ” (*azqaan*) as in 36:8. It figuratively also means the face.

17:107	They fall on their faces	يَخْرُونَ لِأَذْقَانٍ سُجَّدًا
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“الذِّكْرُ” (*az-zikru*) and “الْتَذْكَارُ” (*at-tazkaar*): to make something safe, to make something present in the heart (to imagine something as present). This word has been used against “نَسَى” (*nasee*) in 6:68.

“نَسِيَ” (*nasiyun*) means to forget something, and as such “ذَكَرَ” (*zika*) would mean to recall something.

“إِذْكَرَهُ” (*izkarahu*), “إِسْتَذْكَرَهُ” (*istazkarah*), “تَذَكَّرَهُ” (*tazakkirah*): ordinarily mean to memorize something, but scholars say there is a slight difference in the meaning of the words.

“إِذْكَرَ” (*izkar*) is actually “إِذْتَذَكَّرَ” (*iztutakar*). The “ذ” (*z*) has been omitted because it is heavy on the tongue. Then “ت” (*taa*) was amalgamated in “د” (*daal*). Ergo this word was created.

“الْتَذْكَيرَةُ” (*at-tazkirah*): something which reminds one of the need (79:29).

“الذِّكْرَى” (*az-zikra*): reminder.

“ذَكَرَ حَقَّهُ” (*zakara haqquhu*): his right was protected, not lost.

“أُذْكُرُوا نِعْمَةَ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ” (*ozkuru ne'matallah alaikum*): do not waste the benevolence (favours of) Allah on you and protect them {T}.

“ذَكَرَ” (*zika*): fame as well as to speak kind words about someone, and to respect. It also means “a lesson”.

Zikr also means the book which contains the details about **Deen** and laws about the nation {T}.

“الذِّكَرُ” (*az-zakar*): a strong and brave man, the hardness and sharpness of a sword {T}, also means male when used against “أُنْثَى” (*unsa*), as in 3:35.

“مُذَكَّرٌ” (*muzakkar*): masculine, the opposite of feminine, severe troubles which only men can face {T}.

The Quran has been called “الذِّكَرُ” (*az-zikr*) as in 16:42, because it contains the laws about nations and also historic events. Those who deliberate about the things in the universe have been called “لِقَوْمٍ يَذَّكَّرُونَ” (*liqaumin yaz zakkaroona*) as in 16:13. The struggle against anti-God forces has also been called **zikr**.

That is, the struggle to bring the laws which they (the **mushrikeen**) have ignored (20:42, 20:34). Hence, to be steadfast in the battlefield and Thus, strive to give dominance to Allah's laws have been called **zikr**, as in 8:25. It also means not to ignore the laws of Allah, even in the battlefield, and to always keep them in mind. The laws of Allah themselves are **zikr** as mentioned in 39:23 to mean respect and greatness.

This word has been used in 23:70 as well as in 43:44 where it has been said about the Quran:

43:44	The secret of your greatness and that of your nation is in following the Quran.	إِنَّهُ لَذِكْرٌ لَكَ وَلِقَوْمِكَ
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Surah **Al-Qamar** has said “مُذَكِّرٌ” (*muzakkir*) to mean “one who recalls” in 54:15.

Surah **Ad-Dahar** says that there has been a time when man was unremembered “لَمْ يَكُنْ شَيْئًا مَذْكُورًا” (*lam yakan shaya mazkoora*) (76:1). Here **mazkoora** means something which has come into existence by itself and which is established {T, L}.

In surah **Al-Baqrah**, (2:152) God says “فَإِذَا كُرُّنِي أَذْكُرْكُمْ” (*fa azkuruni azkarkum*). This means that if you uphold my laws then I will protect your rights and grant you greatness and grandeur.

That is, if you follow My laws then their delightful results will certainly be in front of you. Here, it must be noted that the initiative is from Man while God only answers it. The sort of deed that is committed by man gets the same sort of result (i.e. good result for good deeds and bad result for bad deeds). Therefore, “ذَكَرَ اللَّهُ” (*zikrullah*) or the **zikr** of Allah means the following of Allah's orders (and not merely turning the beads of the rosary). The definite result of following these orders is respect and greatness and domination over anti-God forces. For **Ibrahim** to go and confront the Pharaoh (with God's laws) is **zikr** and “تَسْبِيحٌ” (*tasbeeh*). For the meaning of “تَسْبِيحٌ” (*tasbeeh*), see under heading (S-B-H). To be steadfast in the battlefield is **zikr**. To deliberate upon the things of this universe is **zikr**. To keep Allah's laws before one, at every step in every aspect of life is **zikr**. To propagate these laws is also **zikr**. This in today's world is called broadcasting and publishing.

This is the very “ذَكَرَ اللَّهُ” (*zikrullah*) which gives “real” peace to a man (13:28). The ‘real’ has been added because transitory and artificial peace or satisfaction can be obtained through untrue religions as well. Real peace is obtained through deep insight. The only time we reach the conclusion that something is true

is when we have deliberated on something deeply, or when the final results of deeds are before us. Only under these circumstances do we achieve real peace, which is peaceful both for the heart and mind. False peace (satisfaction) is obtained by deceiving oneself. Real peace accrued to the group of **momineen** in the battlefield of **Badr** when they defeated an army three times their size (3:125). Peace is not obtained in secluded rooms or places.

“ذَكَاءٌ” (*dhaka*) basically means for a thing to be completed.

Khalil says “الذَكَاءُ فِي السِّنِّ” (*al-dhaaka'o fis-sin*) means mature age in which a man's capabilities reach their peak.

“الذَّكَاءُ” (*adh-dhaka'o*) means the sharpness and completion of intellect and wit.

“ذَكِيٌّ” (*dhakki*) is one who understands quickly, one who has very sharp intelligence.

“ذَكَتِ النَّارُ” (*dhakatin naar*): the fire flared {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means sharpness and implementation.

“الذَّكِيَّةُ” (*adh-dhakiyyah*) means to slaughter an animal.

“ذَكَاءٌ” (*dhaka*) means temperature and “ذَكِيٌّ” (*dhakka*) means the temperature was taken out.

The Quran says:

5:3	Excepting that which you slaughter ...	إِلَّا مَا ذَكَّيْتُمْ
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“ذَلَّ” (*dhalah*), “ذَلَالَةٌ” (*dhalalah*): when hardness and dogmatisms of something gets to its end, and it becomes obedient.

Raghib says “الذُّلُّ” (*adh-dhull*) means to bend, because when anger and power bow or bend, the harshness becomes mellow on its own. He has also written that when “الذُّلُّ” (*adh-dhill*) is not due to external pressure, it is no more a condemnable trait.

“ذُلُولٌ” (*dhalool*), plural is “ذُلُلٌ” (*dhulul*): one who becomes obedient {T}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:71	The ox which has not been harnessed in the plough.	إِنَّهَا بَقَرَةٌ لَا ذَلُولَ
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“عَيْرُ الْمُذَلَّلَةِ” (*air-ul-muzillah*): an ass which is laden heavily and who is being driven with the help of a stick {M}. This brings the right concept of “ذَلَّتْ” (*dhillat*) before you, which is used for “disgrace”.

“ذُلُّ الْكَرْمِ تَذْلِيلًا” (*dhullilal karmu tazlila*): the bunches of grapes were made low (bent down) {T}.

The Quran has used “تَذِلُّ” (*tudhillu*) against “تُعِزُّ” (*tu-idhu*) in 3:25.

“عِزَّتْ” (*idhat*) means as described therein, to get the government and state (i.e. power) and “ذَلَّتْ” (*dhillat*) means as also described therein, to be deprived of power.

Surah *Yasin* says about cattle:

36:70	Humans have domination over them.	فَهُمْ لَهَا مَالِكُونَ- وَذَلَّلْنَاهَا
36:71	They have been made subservient to man	

Surah *Taha* says “تَذِلَّ وَتُعْزَى” (*nadhilla wa naanadhraa*) in 20:134. It means that in the battlefield this word has come to mean weakness. Also see (3:122).

In surah *Al-Ma'idah* the particularity of the *momineen* has been described as:

5:54	Humble towards momineen and stern towards kafireen	أَذِلَّةٌ عَلَى الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَعِزَّةٌ عَلَى الْكَافِرِينَ
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Ibnul Airabi says here “أَذِلَّةٌ عَلَى الْمُؤْمِنِينَ” (**azillatin alal Momineen**) means the same as “رُحَمَاءَ بَيْنَهُمْ” (**ruhama bainahum**) as in 48:29. That is, they are friendly and kind to one another, while hard on the enemy.

“جَنَاحَ الدَّلِّ” (**janahadhul**): It has appeared for softness and hospitality and kindness.

The Quran has termed a life of “ذِلَّةٌ” (**dhillat**) and weakness as punishment of God (2:61). This ignominy is in this world and can be seen by everybody (7:152). As against it, it has been said that the life of the **momineen** is a life of power and greatness.

63:8	Power and domination is for Allah, his Rusool, His group or party.	وَلِلَّهِ الْعِزَّةُ وَلِرَسُولِهِ وَلِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ
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The life of the **momineen** is “أَعْلَوْنَ” (**a'loon**) as it has been said in 3:138. It's a life of domination and power (24:55). Thus, a life which does not have power and domination is not a life of the **momineen**.

The ignominy in this world is a punishment from Allah.

2:61	And humiliation and misery struck on them and they drew wrath on themselves	وَضُرِبَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ الذِّلَّةُ وَالْمَسْكَنَةُ وَبَاءُوا بِغَضَبٍ مِنَ اللَّهِ
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They were hit by ignominy. That is they became deserving of Allah's punishment.

To believe that by handing this world over to others and to live a life of helplessness and deprivation and ignominy, one can attain spiritual development, is a false concept. This is a mirage that is passed on by the stronger nations to the weak and subjugated nations.

The Quran has come to shatter this false concept. It has openly declared that power, respect, grandeur, wealth, etc. is the natural result of trusting Allah's laws and doing good deeds. A life of deprivation, poverty, ignominy and subjugation is Allah's punishment. It is also said that whoever is in a bad condition in this world, cannot be near Allah in the Hereafter. He whose present is dark will also have a bleak future.

20:124	He who ignores our laws, his earnings will be constricted and on the Day of the Judgment. We will raise him blind	وَمَنْ أَعْرَضَ عَنْ ذِكْرِي فَإِنَّ لَهُ مَعِيشَةً ضَنْكاً وَنَحْشُرُهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ أَعْمَى
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We can all judge ourselves against this criterion.

Dh-M-M ذ م م

“مَذْحُ” (**dhammah**), “يَذْمُ” (**yadhummah**), “ذَمًّا” (**dhamma**), “مَذْمَمَةً” (**madhamma**) are all opposite of “مَدَحٌ” (**madah**) which means to praise. It means that these words mean to bad mouth someone.

“إِسْتَدْهَمَ” (**istadham**): he did a condemnable thing.

“بِمِ ذَمِيمَةٍ” (**bi dhamimah**): he cannot go out of the house due to some sickness or some misfortune {M}.

“مَذْمُومٌ” (**madhmoom**) has been used in 68:49 in these meanings.

“ذِمَّةٌ” (**dhimmah**): any responsibility, pact, agreement, or oral agreement that is not fulfilled and Hence, is condemnable {M}. It is also used for breaking a pact a man is liable to, and Hence, condemned {R}.

“أَذَلَّمَهُ” (**adh-dhimmah**): protection, patronage, guarantee.

“ذِمِّيٌّ” (**dhimmi**): the man who is under a pact, he who has been assured of protection, or he who has been guaranteed in every way.

The Quran says:

9:8	they do not respect any agreement or pact	لَا يَرْفُقُوا فِيكُمْ إِلَّا وَلَا ذِمَّةً
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For details, see heading (A-L-L).

“الذَّنْبُ” (*adh-dhanab*): tail.

“ذَنَّبَهُ” (*dhanbahu*): he tailed him (followed his tail).

“مُسْتَذْنِبٌ” (*mustadhnib*): a man who follows right behind a camel.

“الذَّنَابُ” (*adh-dhinaab*): the back part of anything.

“ذَنْبَةُ الْوَادِي” (*dhanbatul wadi*): the last part of the valley.

“الذَّنَابَةُ” (*adh-dhunabah*): one who follows behind.

Raghib says that “الذَّنْبُ” (*adh-dhunb*) basically means the back part of anything or the tail. Hence, it means every deed which has a bad ending. The result of any deed is Therefore, called “ذَنْبٌ” (*dhanb*) because it follows the act {M}. This word is also used to mean sin and crime.

The Quran says:

91:14	they were destroyed by their Sustainer due to their crimes	فَدَمَدَمَ عَلَيْهِمْ رَبُّهُمْ بِذُنُوبِهِمْ
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So in the above verse, the meaning is of crime.

“ذَنْبٌ” (*dhanab*) also means a mean person.

Since a tail is always behind an animal, Therefore, “ذَنْبٌ” (*dhunub*) is also those allegations which are in a way stuck to somebody's back. “الْقِفْوَةُ” (*al-qifwah*) means a tail but it also means allegation. See heading (Q-F-W)

Surah **Al-Fateh** says about the Messenger **Mohammed (pbuh)**:

48:2	This great victory is being granted so that you are protected from all the allegations that your opponents level against you or will level against you.	لِيُغْفَرَ لَكَ اللَّهُ مَا تَقَدَّمَ مِنْ ذَنْبِكَ وَمَا تَأَخَّرَ
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The opponents used to say that the Messenger's claims (God forbid) are false. He is demented. Somebody had worked a spell on him. He paints rosy pictures with no basis and deceives people. God says this great victory, which has broken the back of the opposing forces, is proof of the fact that at last you were proven right. See more under heading (Q-D-M).

“ذَنْبٌ” (*dhanoob*) means a horse with a bushy tail. It also means a big bucket (used to fetch water from a well) which is full of water, while if it is empty then it is called “دَلُو” (*dalu*). It also means a day of unending miseries.

Surah **Adh-dhurriyaat** says:

51:59	those who are being oppressive will share the fate of those who were like them	فَإِنَّ لِلَّذِينَ ظَلَمُوا ذُنُوبًا مِثْلَ ذُنُوبِ أَصْحَابِهِمْ
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Taj, Muheet and **Raghib** say that “ذَنْبٌ” (*dhanub*) means share or luck. It is Therefore, that the above verse has been translated as such.

Some people out of humbleness call themselves sinners etc. “مُذْنِبٌ” (*mudhanb*) or sin is a crime against God's laws. When we do not like being called criminals, then why call ourselves sinners (even if it is only out of humility)? If we have actually committed some crime then we should be ashamed of it rather than make it a distinguishing mark!

“ذَهَابٌ” (*dhahaab*): to go, to pass by.
 “ذَهَبَ بِهِ” (*dhahaba behi*): to take away.
 “ذَهَبَ عَلَى كَذَا” (*dhahaba alayya kaza*): I forgot that thing.

If “عَنْ” (*un*) appears with “ذَهَبَ” (*dhahab*), then it means to leave, while if “إِلَى” (*ila*) comes with it then it means to be attentive {*T*}.

Kashaaf says that “أَذْهَبَهُ” (*adhaabahu*) means eliminated it, pushed it away or took it away (46:20).
 “ذَهَبَ بِهِ” (*dhahaba behi*): took him away along with him. That is, went with him {*M*}.

The Quran says “ذَهَبَ اللَّهُ بِنُورِهِمْ” (*dhahaballahu benoorihim*) in 2:17. Here it means to take away, not to go along with him.

“الْمَذْهَبُ” (*al-madh-hab*): to go, a place to go to, the way to go, the method to follow, the concept towards which one leans, religion to follow. It also means the latrine where one goes for defecating. The Quran has not used this form of the word “مَذْهَبُ” (*madh-hab*) anywhere. For “Islam” the word “دِينُ” (*deen*) has been used.

“مَذْهَبُ” (*madh-hab*) actually means “a school of thought”.

In the beginning the word for Islam was only “دِينُ” (*deen*), when different sects were created due to thoughts of different scholars, religion or *madh-hab* replaced *deen*.

“ذَهَبَ فِي الدِّينِ مَذْهَبًا” (*dhahaba fiddeen madh-haba*): he followed a certain concept about *Deen*.
 “فَلَانٌ يَذْهَبُ إِلَى قَوْلِ أَبِي حَنِيفَةَ” (*falanun yazhabu ila qaului abi hanifah*): man follows the sect of *Imam Hanifa* {*L*}.

This way the *Deen* (the way of life which Allah had given us) was lost and various religions which were attributed to different personalities began to flourish. Until and unless these religions are not erased, *Deen* will be pushed kept hidden in the background. By “erasing” the religions, it means that they should only be given the importance that they are a way of thinking, not a way to live by as *Deen* is. Alternatively, these were the details which they had determined according to their time. They were not permanent. Permanence is only for *Deen* which is contained in the Quran. As such, whatever has come to us in the form of religion from our forefathers must be judged on the criterion of the Quran. Whatever the Quran says to be right must be taken to be right, and whatever it says is false must be rejected.

As far as philosophical details are concerned, they cannot be permanent because they will be determined according to the time we are passing through, under the overall guidance of Quranic laws. Since in the West, Christianity only holds the status of a religion, Therefore, they also call Islam a religion (whereas it is a *Deen*). The concept of *Deen* has been eradicated, and Islam too was understood to be a religion among other religions of the world, although Islam is a *Deen* (way of life) not religion.

About the basic meaning of the word religion, there is a difference among scholars but they agree on the meaning “respect for the gods”. Thereafter the worship of any meta-physical being was called religion and this is the meaning which currently holds sway. (See the Century Dictionary). Obviously, Islam is not a religion in this sense, because it is a complete code of life. Therefore, Islam must not be called “religion”.

Religion or *madh-hab* is the product of the times when the human mind or knowledge was in its infancy. Man could not understand that the events in this universe take place according to the laws framed by God. Since he did not understand their cause, he genuflected before them and tried to woo them with presents and sacrifices. He used to find ways with which he could reach them, and looked for someone to intervene between him and them. Man’s own superstition created the gods and goddesses and Thus, he

began to worship them. Those who were cleverer made themselves out to be near the gods or their friends and exploited simple folk. They began to be worshipped themselves. Thus, were the institutions of religious leadership and spiritual rulers. The ruling clique too came close to them and Thus, became the ‘avatar’ (incarnations of God). The simple folks were taught that they (the religious and temporal rulers) had been granted powers by the gods. All these concepts together made up religion that prevails even today among humans.

To dispel this falsehood of religion, **Deen** continued to be presented by God through the Messengers. It made man realize his true place in the universe. It also said everything in the universe is working according to the laws made by God and man had been given the knowledge to harness these forces and utilize them for the benefit of the entire human race. It (**Deen**) has supported its claims with reasoning and invited man to accept them with his knowledge and insight. God’s **Deen** is completely secure in the Quran and is a living challenge to religion. Since man’s knowledge and insight is increasing, the supremacy of religion is being eroded. Thus, the path for the establishment of the **Deen** is being prepared. The world is gradually becoming frustrated with the concepts of capitalism, hegemonies and religious leadership. These are signs to that God’s **Deen** will one day bloom with all its delights. Now man is reaching a mature era and can neither be frightened of his own superstitions nor be content with false happiness. Now it can only be content with the solid facts of life which cannot be found anywhere else but in the Quran.

“الذَّهَبُ” (**adh-dhahab**), as used in 18:31, means the gold which has been purified after being mined. The gold which is still within the mine and which has not been melted and purified is called “تَبْر” (**tibr**).
 “مُذَبَّبٌ” (**mudhahab**): anything which has gold plating.
 “ذَيْبَ الرَّجُلِ” (**dhahabir rujul**) is said when a man is awestruck by seeing a lot of gold in a mine.
 “الذَّيْبَةُ” (**adh-dhihbah**): slight rain or largesse {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to go, as well as beauty and freshness.

Dh-He-L ذ ه ل

“ذَهَلَهُ” (**dhahlah**), “ذَهَلَ عَنْهُ” (**dhahala unhu**): to leave, to give up something even though there is some contact, or to give up knowingly, or to forget due to being engaged in something else.

Some say “ذُهِبَتْ” (**dhuhooh**) means for the memories of the beloved to fade away and despite its absence, for the heart to be happy and feel no loss {T}.

Muheet has added that “ذُهِبَتْ” (**dhuhooh**) means to give up one’s beloved one due to some fright.
 “ذَهَلَ” (**dhahil**) means for someone to lose his/her senses {M}.

Ibn Faris says the word basically means to forget about something due to worries and troubles.

The Quran says:

22:2	When you see it (Qaiyamah) every mother will stop feeding her child and every pregnant woman will abort her fetus.	يَوْمَ تَرَوْنَهَا تَذْهَلُ كُلُّ مُرْضِعَةٍ عَمَّا أَرْضَعَتْ وَتَضَعُ كُلُّ ذَاتِ حَمْلٍ حَمْلَهَا
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This is said about the frightening aspect of that ‘moment’ (the Day of the Judgment). But if it is taken to mean the revolutionary era, then it draws a picture of our times in which no woman wants to feed her baby and no woman (despite being married) is willing to be pregnant. And they do not feel any compunction at giving up these feminine duties but instead they are very happy. They consider these things to be a hindrance in their other engagements.

“ذَهَلَ” (**dhahal**) connotes all these meanings. It also means the troublesome lives that we lead and in this way become oblivious of our other responsibilities.

“ذُو” (*dhu*) means having. Its plurals are “ذَوُونَ” (*dhawoon*), “ذَوِينَ” (*dhaween*) and “أُولُو” (*oolu*). Feminine form is “ذَاتٌ” (*dhaat*). Feminine plural is “ذَوَاتَانِ” (*dhawataan*). According to a rule “ذُو” (*dhu*) can sometimes become “ذِي” (*dhee*) or “ذَا” (*dhaa*).

2:280	one who is poor, has poverty	ذُو عُسْرَةٍ
41:51	one who prays for long	قَدْ ذُو دُعَاءٍ عَرِيضٍ
2:177	Relatives	ذَوِي الْقُرْبَى
18:18	on the right and left side	ذَاتِ الْيَمِينِ وَذَاتِ الشِّمَالِ
3:153	whatever is inside the heart (whatever thoughts are in the mind)	بِذَاتِ الصُّدُورِ
55:28	scholars of different sciences and arts	ذَوَاتَا أَفْقَانٍ

Dhulqarnain

ذو القرنين

“ذو القرنين” (*Dhulqarnain*) was the kind king of Persia who liberated the Jews from the captivity of the Babylonians, and allowed them to settle down in Jerusalem. The Quran has discussed him in detail in surah *Al-Kahaf* 18:83-101. For details see heading (Q-R-N).

Dh-W-D

ذ و د

“الذَّوْدُ” (*adh-dhud*): to drive, push away, to scold and oust, to remove.

“الْمَذْوَدُ” (*al-midhwad*): the place where the animals are fed; it also means the horns of the ox with which he defends himself or keeps others away from him {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to separate something from another and make it one sided.

Surah *Al-Qasas* says that when *Moosa* reached *Madyan*, he saw that people's animals (which came later) drank their fill and departed, but two girls stood there and waited with their animals (presumably for their turn). “تَكْوَدَانِ” (*tadhudaan*) as used in 28:23 means that those animals strained at their leash to get a drink but the girls restrained them. This has been termed as “الذَّوْدُ” (*adh-dhood*). *Moosa* was surprised as to why these girls had been restraining their animals from getting a drink. He asked the girls about this and they replied:

28:23	We cannot let our animals get a drink as long as these (powerful shepherds) do not return after that their animals have had their drink.	حَتَّى يُصْدِرَ الرِّعَاءُ
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They also told him the reason for this:

28:24	(We are girls and weaker than men) and our father is very old. Therefore, we cannot dare to let our animals drink before these others.	وَأَبُونَا شَيْخٌ كَبِيرٌ
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Note how the Quran has told the entire human story in a few words. This has been happening all over the world that the animals of the strong or wealthy drink first (these people are prioritized) and if later anything remains, then the poor animals can have a lifesaving drink.

Only those who come with a celestial program are the exception to this rule. It is their duty to let the weaker animals drink in their turn, exactly as **Moosa** did.

28:23	(Without any remuneration) arranged for the girls' animals to have a drink.	فَسَلَّى لَهُم
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This is what the Messengers came for, and their left system will do likewise (7:22). That is, the sources of sustenance that are currently dominated by a few will be made available to entire mankind. **Moosa** had not been declared a messenger yet, but he was naturally inclined towards such (good) deeds.

Dh-W-Q ذ و ق

“ذَاقَ” (*dhaaq*): to find out the taste of something, to taste {*T*}.

Raghib says this word actually means to eat a little.

Ibn Faris says it means to eat something and find out about its internal condition.

Then it began to be used for every experiment {*M*}. That is, to have the experience of something.

7:22	when they had experienced the “شجره” (<i>shajarah</i>) (fraction)	فَلَمَّا ذَاقَا الشَّجَرَةَ
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“أَذَاقَ” (*adhaaq*): to let someone have a taste of something (16:112).

“ذَائِقٌ” (*dhaaiq*): one who tastes, one who gains the experience (3:182). Feminine form is “ذَائِقَةٌ” (*dhaaiqah*).

In the Quran, this word has generally been used with punishment, although at some places it has also appeared with “رَحْمَةً” (*rahmah*). This means that man should feel his deeds in such a way as to have tasted or experienced them, so that he knows firsthand what may be the result of that deed.

Dh-Y-Ain ذ ي ع

“ذَاعَ” (*dha'a*), “يَذِيْعُ” (*yadhi'o*): to spread something, for something to become common.

“أَذَاعَ سِرَّهُ” (*dha'a sirrah*): he disclosed his secret and made it public knowledge.

Zajaj says it means to call out and tell the people, to announce {*T*, *M*}.

The Quran says:

4:83	When some information about peace or fear reaches them, they spread it around	وَإِذَا جَاءَهُمْ أَمْرٌ مِنَ الْأَمْنِ أَوِ الْخَوْفِ أَذَاعُوا بِهِ
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“الرَّأْسُ” (*ar-raas*), plural is “رُؤُوسٌ” (*ruoos*) basically means head, or the top part of anything. “رَيْسٌ” (*raiys*) can therefore be used for head or leader of a nation.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to come together and to be elevated or high.

“رَأْسُ الْمَالِ” (*raasul maal*): capital.

“الرَّائِسُ” (*arra-is*): ruler.

“الرُّؤُوسُ” (*al-marooos*): the subjects (the ruled) {T}.

The Quran says in context of the performance of *Hajj*:

2:196	Do not shave off your heads.	وَلَا تَحْلِقُوا رُؤُوسَكُمْ
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(See under heading (H-L-Q)).

For capital wealth it is said:

2:279	Capital.	رُؤُوسُ أَمْوَالِكُمْ
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“الرَّافَةُ” (*ar-rafaah*), “رَحْمَتٌ” (*rahma*) and “رَافَتْ” (*raaft*) are words with similar meanings.

Muheet says “رَافَةُ” (*rafaah*) means to free you of matters that are harmful, and “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rehmah*) is to benefit you.

This has been supported by *Al-minar* which says that the result of “رَافَةُ” (*rafa*) is to banish the ills, while “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) is to grant benefits in abundance. {*Al-minar* vol-II page 122}.

Therefore, “رُؤُوفٌ” (*raoof*) and “رَحِيمٌ” (*rahim*) together cover both negative and positive aspects.

Hence, it means to remove or banish such things or matters which are harmful, and prevent the smooth development of one's being, and together with that, provide such things that are helpful for development.

As to how Allah's “رَافَتْ” (*rafat*) and “رَحِمَتْ” (*rehmat*) are, it is said in surah *Al-Baqarah*:

2:143	Allah never lets someone's eeman (faith) go unprotected and never leaves him with no result, He is raooofur raheem.	وَمَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيُضَيِّعَ إِيمَانَكُمْ إِنَّ اللَّهَ بِالنَّاسِ لَرُؤُوفٌ رَحِيمٌ
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That means, He removes all the obstacles that hinder a man's faith bearing result and creates good results of the faith. Therefore, his *rafat* and *rehmat* are the result of faith. This is the right way for humanity to develop. Faith means to believe in the veracity of God's laws and to make it one's life's duty to obey Him.

Since generally the feeling to banish someone's ills is created by the softening of the heart.

As such “رَافَةُ” (*raafeh*) also means softness.

In surah *An-Noor*, it has been said regarding the punishment for fornication:

24:2	Do not be soft in implementing God's orders. (Do not be soft thinking that the punishment will hurt them and thus not punish them (the fornicators) at all)	وَلَا تَأْخُذْكُمْ بِهِمَا رَأْفَةٌ فِي دِينِ اللَّهِ
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Because, if the criminals are not punished, then how can the victims be redressed. Christianity was soft on the criminals out of pity which made them brazen and gradually the religion had to be confined to the churches and politics became unbridled. The Quran has said about monasticism that it was a fabricated sect (or concept) and the wrong interpretation of “رُفُوفٌ رَحِيمٌ” (*raofur-reheem*). 57.27
Islam teaches justice for which the forces that commit excesses have to be broken. Therefore, it requires harshness along with kindness. See under heading (Gh-L-Zd).

R-A-Y

ر أ ي

“رُؤْيَا” (*rooyah*): to comprehend some material thing.

This word is used for seeing with the eyes, or have insight, or to dream or think about it.

Johri says that when it appears with one subject, only then it means seeing with the eye, and when two subjects appear with it then it means to acquire knowledge or to know.

Raghib says that when it is followed by two subjects then it means knowledge and when it is followed by “إِلَى” (*ila*), it means to look at a thing (or deliberate on something) so that it imparts a lesson {*T*}.

Muheet says that “رَأَى رُؤْيَا” (*ra-ai rooyah*) means to see with the eyes. “رُؤْيَا” (*rowayah*) means to dream and “رَأَى” (*raaya*) to deliberate or see from the heart. That is, deeply deliberate on something.

“الرَّأْيُ” (*al-marai*, “الرَّأْهَ” (*al-mar'ah*): scene.

“الرَّأْيُ” (*al-mirah*): mirror.

“الرَّوْيَا” (*arrooyah*): dream.

“الرَّأْيُ” (*arrayu*): opinion, thought, to have an opinion about a matter which is not definite {*T*}.

“أَرَأَيْتَ” (*araaitak*) as used in 107:1 is the way the Arabs usually say: “will you inform him?”, or “will you tell me?”

“أَلَمْ تَرَ إِلَى” (*alam tara ila*) is said at a time of surprise. It means “do you not see?” That is, don't you wonder about it? {*T*}. But at the times when these words are spoken, it is also an invitation to look at the thing with a view to learning a lesson.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:12	They were seeing them twice of them with the sight of their eyes	يَرَوْنَهُمْ رَأَى الْعَيْنِ
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Here it comes for reiteration and to clarify, as we say “seen with my own eyes” etc.

Surah *Maryam* says “رِئْيًا” (*ri'ya*) in 19:74 where it means a scene or apparent condition. “رِئَاءَ النَّاسِ” (*ria-annaas*) as in 2:264, means “for people's sake”, i.e. only to show people.

4:142	show the people	رِئَاءَ النَّاسِ
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“يُتَمَرِّئُونَ” (*hoom yuraoon*): they show the people that they are true followers but they have lost the soul of *salaah*. That is, the fountainheads of sustenance which should be kept open are blocked (for personal gains) and denied to people (107:7)

Surah *Al-Momin* says:

40:29	I tell you only that which I comprehend	مَا أُرِيكُمْ إِلَّا مَا أَرَى
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Surah *Ash-Shura* says:

26:61	When both the groups or parties saw each other	فَلَمَّا تَرَآءِ الْجُمُعِينَ
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“بَادَى الرَّأْيَ” (*baadiar ra'ya*) as in 11:27, but for its meaning, see under heading (B-D-W).

“رَبُّ” (*rabb*) means to nurture or to develop. That is, to pass a thing through ever-new changes or stages so it gradually develops and reaches its ultimate destination {R}. It can be explained just as Mother Nature passes a particle through several stages and changes it into a pearl while gradually nurturing it on its way {T}.

This method of nurturing is called “رَبَوِيَّةٌ” (*raboobiyyat*).

“رَبَّ وَلَدَهُ رَبًّا وَرَبَّيَهُ” (*rabba waladahu wa rabb wa rabbanah*): he brought up the child, looked after him till he became an adult.

Hisaan bin Saabit's verse says the (one who is praised) is more beautiful than the pure and white pearl that has been nurtured in the depths of the sea.

Ibn Faris says it basically means

- to look after something and beautify it.

“الرَّبُّ” (*ar-rabbu*), “مَالِكٌ” (*maalik*), “خَالِقٌ” (*khaliq*), all mean one who looks after and improves a thing.

- to stay unmoved and stable.

“أَرَبَّتِ السَّحَابَةُ بِهَذِهِ الْبَلَدَةِ” (*arabbatis sahabatu behaazehil baladah*): the cloud kept hovering over the city or kept raining.

- To join something with something. Therefore, to continuously nurture and fine tune a thing is called “رَبَوِيَّةٌ” (*raboobiyyat*).

Figuratively, patting a child to sleep is called “رَبَّتِ الْمَرْأَةُ صَبِيَّهَا” (*rabbatil mar'atu sabiyyaha*) {T}, because the time a child sleeps peacefully has a direct bearing on his growth.

For correcting something and establishing its solidarity, it is said “رَبَّ” (*rabba*), “يُرَبُّ” (*yarubbu*), “رَبًّا” (*rabba*) {T} and also to gather something and increase it continuously.

“رَبَابَةٌ” (*ribaaba*) is the pack in which a lot of arrows are kept.

“رَبَّ الدُّهْنِ” (*rabbud duhn*): he improved (refined) the oil and made it perfumed {M}.

Since the result of nurturing is positive flowering, “الرَّيْبَةُ” (*arribbah*) also means the plants which do not wither even in winter but they are evergreen {T}.

“الرَّيْبُ” (*al-marabbu*) is the land which is evergreen with trees and plants {T}.

“الرَّيْبَةُ” (*ar-rubbah*) means a lot of bushy trees, a very big party (nearly of ten thousand or so) or the abundance of luxuries {T}.

Al Qateeba writes that a party is called “رَبِّيٌّ” (*rabbiiy*). Its plural is “رَبِّيُّونَ” (*ribiyyoon*) {T} (See 3:145).

“الرَّيْبَةُ” (*ar-rababah*): layer upon layer of the clouds {T}.

“الرَّيْبُ” (*ar-ribab*): sweet (potable) water which has gathered somewhere in abundance {T}.

“الرَّيْبَةُ” (*ar-rabibah*): pact or agreement. It also means the state, because in a state one nation mingles with the other {M}.

“الرَّيْبَةُ” (*ar-rabibah*) is the singular of “رَبَائِبُ” (*rabayib*). It means a girl who comes with a woman and who are the progeny of the woman's first husband. The she-goat which is nurtured at home rather than the grazing fields so that its milk can be had when required {T}.

The above makes the meaning of “رَبُّ” (*rabb*) clear, as the one who nurtures. It means one who takes something to completion, one who arranges, and one who improves. Therefore, the nation’s leader is called “رَبُّ الْقَوْمِ” (*rabb-ul-qaum*), and the man of the house is called “رَبُّ الْبَيْتِ” (*rabb-ul-bait*) {T}. “رَبُّ الْقَوْمِ” (*rabb-ul-qaum*) means that he took the affairs of the state in hand and led the nation {T}.

“رَبُّ” (*rabb*) can also mean elder brother {*Muntahil Arab*}. When the *Bani Israel* said to *Moosa*:

5:24	you and your elder brother (Haroon) should go and fight the enemy.	فَاذْهَبْ أَنْتَ وَرَبُّكَ فَقَاتِلَا
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It is possible that they were being sarcastic when they said that.

“الرَّبَّانِيُّ” (*ar-rabbani*): that which is attributed to Rabb, or the teacher who first nurtures the mind of his pupils by first giving them small doses of knowledge before giving really big ones. Every scholar is called “رَبَّانِي” (*rabbani*), as well as those with the right knowledge {T}. “رَبِّي” (*rabbi*) is also used in these meanings.

The Quran begins with:

1:1	every beautiful aspect of the universe is an epitome of praise for the Sustenance by the Rab	الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ
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Everything in the universe is testimony to the fact that a wonderful program or scheme is at work. In this program a seed, while traversing different stages of nurturing, reaches fruition. This is what the system of God’s sustenance is. Allah is praiseworthy because He nurtures everything.

Just as this system of God’s sustenance is at work automatically in the internal and external universe, so should human beings implement and establish His *Nizaam-e-raboobiyat*, that is, the system of sustenance in their social lives. The way to do it is to make the fountainheads of sustenance as well as the capabilities of the humans available to all. Thus, all of humanity’s latent capabilities will flourish and reach their completion or peak. Those who establish such a system will be called *rabbaniyyoon* (3:78) and this system can be established by following the Quranic system. This is the crux of all Quranic teachings. That is, the establishment of God’s sustenance. Since this involves man’s physical being as well as his personality, it is the duty of an Islamic state to establish a system which caters not only to every individual’s needs but is also conducive equally for the development of his capabilities. When a man’s personality is nurtured in this way, then death too makes no difference, because life goes ahead to traverse other stages, i.e. the life hereafter. God’s sustenance continues there as well.

Universal sustenance is the purpose and aim of an Islamic society. That is, the sustenance of mankind regardless of caste, race, color, creed, or religion. Until such system of sustenance is reflected in a human society, it cannot be called an Islamic society. This is the beginning of Quranic teaching.

He, in whom this trait of *raboobiyat* is reflected, uses all his strength to earn. Whatever part of his earning which is beyond his needs, he gives to the central authority of this system for the sustenance of others (a welfare state). That is why in such a society, no concept of building estates or accumulating wealth takes root. In such a system no one tries to hold dominance over the fountainheads of sustenance, neither does anyone usurp the fruits of others’ labor. This is the sort of society that the Quran wants to build, and only such a system can show the world how praiseworthy Allah’s system can be. This is the manifestation of “الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ” (*al-hamdo-lilla-hi rabbil aalameen*) or all praise is for Allah.

رُبَّ (حرف) Rubba (letter)

“رُبَّ” (*rubba*), “رُبَّ” (*ru*ba), “رُبَّمَا” (*rubbama*), “رُبَّمَا” (*rubama*). It is used to express as we say ‘most of the time’. ‘it happens often,, ‘generally, this is the condition,’ etc. This is also used for reiteration and for expressing intensity, like we say “no matter how much he wanted”, or “no matter how many times they tried” etc.

15:2	The deniers will wish very much to have been Muslims too	رُبَّمَا يَوَدُّ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا لَوُكَانُوا مُسْلِمِينَ
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Alternatively, these people will always wish that they had been Muslims. This word is also used to mean “sometimes”. The context in the Quran can determine what the word means.

ر ب ح R-B-H

“رِبْحٌ” (*rabih*): the profit that accrues in a trade {R}

Ibn Faris too says it means success or increase in trade or business.

“رِبْحٌ” (*ribhun*) and “رَبَاحٌ” (*rabah*): increase and progress in trade {T}.

“أَرَبَحَ النَّاقَةَ” (*arbahān naaqaḥ*): it is said when a man milks the she-camel in the morning, or at noon.

“تَرَبَّحَ الرَّجُلُ” (*tarabbahāḥ al-rajul*): the man was surprised, awestruck {T, M}.

The Quran says:

2:16	Their trade gave them no profit	تَرَبَّحَ الرَّجُلُ
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ر ب ص R-B-Sd

“تَرَبَّصْ” (*tarabbas*): to wait for some good or bad thing {T}, or to wait for something to be cheaper or dearer or for something to happen or disappear {R}.

In surah *Al-Baqrah* this word has been used to wait:

2:226	Those who swear not to sleep with their women should abstain or wait for four months.	لِّلَّذِينَ يُؤَلُّونَ مِن نِّسَاءِهِمْ تَرَبُّصُ أَرْبَعَةِ أَشْهُرٍ
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Within four months, they will have to decide whether they want to keep the women in their wedlock or divorce them. They cannot leave them in the lurch indefinitely.

“مُتَرَبِّصٌ” (*mutzarabbisun*): one who waits.

ر ب ط R-B-Te

“رَبَطَهُ” (*rabatahu*): tied him up.

“الرِّبَاطُ” (*ar-ribaṭ*): that which is used for tying.

”الرَّابِطَةُ“ (*ar-rabitah*): relation, ties.

Ibn Faris says this root means tying or securing something tightly as well as solidarity.

”الرَّابِطُ“ (*ar-ribaah*): to do something continuously, to watch out for the enemy permanently.

”رِبَاطُ الْخَيْلِ“ (*ribaatul khail*): to make army posts at the border to guard the frontiers {T} (8:60).

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says:

3:200	Be steadfast and patient and constant	إصْبِرُوا وَصَابِرُوا وَرَبِّطُوا
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Here ”رَابِطُوا“ (*raabituh*) means to make foolproof arrangements for one’s security, or to remain united, or to continuously strive for a purpose.

”رَبَطَ اللَّهُ عَلَى قَلْبِهِ“ (*rabatullahu ala qalbehi*): Allah gave him patience and strengthened his heart {T}.

Surah *Al-Anfaal* says:

8:11	So that he strengthens your hearts and makes you steadfast	وَلِيَرْبِطَ عَلَى قُلُوبِكُمْ وَيُثَبِّتَ بِهِ الْأَقْدَامَ
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”إِرْتِبَاطُ“ (*irtibaat*): to be tied with one another, to be in a relationship {T}.

R-B-Ain ر ب ع

”أَرْبَعَةٌ“ (*arba’ah*): the figure four (4). It is the masculine form (2:260).

”أَرْبَعُونَ“ (*arbaton*) is the feminine form (24:6).

”أَرْبَعُونَ“ (*arba’on*), ”أَرْبَعِينَ“ (*arba’een*): forty (2:51).

”الرُّبْعُ“ (*ar-rub’o*): one fourth (4:12).

”رُبَاعٌ“ (*rub’a*): four each (3:2).

”رَابِعٌ“ (*raabi-un*): fourth (18:22).

Ibn Faris says that besides meaning the figure four, the word means to be stolid, or to last and to elevate.

R-B-W ر ب و

”رَبَا“ (*raba*), ”يَرْبُو“ (*yarbu*): to exceed, to be more, to be in excess, to increase, to swell {T, M}.

30:39	So that the people’s wealth grows	لِيَرْبُوا فِي أَمْوَالِ النَّاسِ
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It also means for a vegetable to grow and swell {T, M}.

22:5	He mixed water in with seeds and the seeds swelled	رَبَا السَّوْفِيُّ
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”رَابٌ“ (*raab*) with its feminine form ”رَابِيَةٌ“ (*raabiah*): that which climbs to the top.

”زَبَادًا رَابِيًا“ (*zabadar raabia*): the scum that comes up on top (13:17).

”أَخَذَهُ رَابِيَةً“ (*akhzatan raabia*): strong grip, a grip which has grown very strong {T, M}. It means a grip which overshadows a man and overpowers him (69:10).

”أَرْبًا“ (*arba*): too much, very wealthy {T, M} 16:92.

”رَبْوَةٌ“ (*rabwah*): high part of land, i.e. a plateau {T, M}.

”رَبَّيْتُهُ“ (*rabbaituhu*): I fed him. (See heading **(R-B-B)**), as in 17:24.

”الرِّبَا“ (*ar-riba*): interest which is received on a loan. To take more than the capital {M} (details further ahead).

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:129	Do not take interest.	لَا تَأْكُلُوا الرِّبَا أَضْعَافًا مُّضَاعَفَةً
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You may think that it increases your wealth but in fact it decreases your national wealth. See under heading (Zd-Ain-F). The economic system proposed by the Quran has no place for interest. When in this system, the accumulation of wealth is forbidden, then the question of even loans hardly arises, leave alone interest,. In this system, nobody has any surplus money. It is distributed among the society. Whatever laws about loans are contained in the Quran belong to the era when a Quranic economic system had not taken shape.

Let alone interest, in this system no one can even make a gift hoping that he would get a bigger present in return.

30:39	Whatever you give people more than what is due, hoping that it would be increased (in return) then in the system of God, it cannot be increased.	وَمَا تَيْسَّرُ مِنْ رَّيًّا لِيَرْزُقُوا فِي أَمْوَالِ النَّاسِ
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Taj has said it means gift but we believe that this is said for everything that is more than due.

This has been explained at another place as follows:

74:6	Do not do someone a favor in the hope of getting a better return	لَا تَتَّبِعُوا تَتَابَعَةً
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This system is based on ”إِيَّآ زَكَاةً“ (*iyta zakat*). That is, to provide the means for others’ development or nurture. That is why in 30:39 ”زَكَاةً“ (*zakat*) has been used opposite to ”رَبًّا“ (*riba*) as interest.

The Quran has declared interest as forbidden by saying:

2:275	Allah has made trade as permissible and interest as forbidden.	وَأَحَلَّ اللَّهُ الْبَيْعَ وَحَرَّمَ الرِّبَا
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The question is what **riba** or interest is? **Riba** according to the Quran is the opposite of business and trade. As to what business is, has been explained under heading (B-Y-Ain). Let us go over it briefly once more.

Whatever we get or take from others can be many different things as gift, remuneration, interest, profit in a business or a win on gambling. Let us see how they are different.

- Gift: One has to do no labor or employ any capital for it. The giver gives it without any thought of getting anything in return. Thus, it cannot be brought under the category of give and take. Therefore, it is out of our present purview.
- Remuneration: This is the payment for labor. No capital is needed to employ in it.
- Interest: In this, capital is provided to somebody and something more than the capital given is received. There is no employment of labor in it.
- Profit (in business and trade): In this, capital as well as labor is employed.
- Gambling: Neither capital nor labor is employed in it.

The principle as related by the Quran is:

53:39	For a man there is nothing but the fruit of his labor	لَيْسَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ إِلَّا مَا سَعَى
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That is, only the compensation for labor is permissible while the compensation for the use of capital is not permissible. Since at that time this principle was not before the people at that time, they were unable to understand what the difference between profit and interest was.

A man purchases something for a hundred bucks, sells it for ten bucks more, and earns a profit of ten bucks. Another man lends a hundred bucks to someone and receives back a hundred and ten. He too receives ten bucks more. They argued that ten bucks were received by both over the principal amount. So where is the difference?

2:275	They used to consider both bai and riba as the same	ذَٰلِكَ بِأَنَّهُمْ قَالُوا إِنَّمَا الْبَيْعُ مِثْلُ الرِّبَا
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But the Quran said that they are not the same. In **bai**, i.e. trade and business, both capital and labor are employed, the capital is returned and the profit in the form of compensation for the trader comes back. This is permissible. But in **riba** (interest) only capital is employed. There is no labor required from the investor. Therefore, whatever more is received back is the compensation for the capital which is forbidden. Therefore, according to the Quran, remuneration for labor is permissible but it is **haraam** to take back more than the capital.

If in trade too, one takes more than the compensation for his labor then that is interest (**riba**) which is forbidden. As to what is the correct remuneration for his labor, will be decided by the society. He can- not take above that. Therefore, any trade or business in which somebody only by employing capital gets back more than the capital is **riba** and according to the Quran it is forbidden, whether it is trade on land or being a sleeping partner in some business. This is called un-earned income. That is, the income which is received without any labor.

When neither capital nor labor is employed, then that is gambling. See heading (Y-S-R). Generally, it is though that business involves risk. That is, both profit and loss can be expected. And **riba** has no risk involved. This criterion is not right. If the criteria for an income be risk to make it permissible, then gambling should also be permitted because every hand involves a risk. The difference between **bai** and **riba** is that which has been explained above.

In trade or business, capital plus remuneration for labor is received back. And in **riba** capital plus the remuneration on the utilization of capital is received. The remuneration for capital is forbidden, whether it is called interest or profit. According to the Quranic economy, remuneration for capital can in no case be allowed. If an Islamic system is yet to be established in a society, when the responsibility for the needs of life is not on society, then the return of capital plus a day's labor of a shopkeeper can be compensated. Moreover, when the Islamic society fulfills the needs of a shopkeeper, then things will be supplied free of cost. God knows how much time man needs to establish an Islamic system. Nevertheless, whatever time it takes, man can get out of his self-made hell (**jahannum**) when he does establish such a system. The present system in which the remuneration for the utilization of capital is thought permitted and not impure, is a war against Allah's system (2:279).

R-T-Ain ر ت ع

“رَتَعَ” (**rata**), “يَرْتَعُ” (**yarta-o**), “رَتَا” (**rataa**): to eat and drink in a green spot and to move around at will. “رَتَعَ” (**rat-un**) is actually used for grazing of animals but later it began metaphorically to be used for humans too {T, M, R}. “جَمَلٌ رَاتِعٌ” (**jamalun rati-un**), with plural “إِبِلٌ رِتَا” (**iblun rita un**): a camel which eats and drinks freely. “الْمَرْتَعُ” (**al-marta-u**): grazing land. “ارْتَعَتِ الْأَرْضُ” (**arta atil ard**): the grass and fodder grew in the land in abundance {T, M, R}.

Surah **Yusuf** relates that **Yusuf's** (Joseph) brothers asked their father to allow them to take **Yusuf** out with them to the jungle:

12:12	So that he eats and drinks happily and plays around.	يَرْتَعُ وَيَلْعَبُ
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“يَرْتَعُ وَيَلْعَبُ” (**yartah wa yal'ab**): practically means what we call ‘picnic’ today.

“رَتَقُ” (*ratq*): to fill a hole. It also means a joined thing.

“إِرْتَتَقَ الشَّيْءُ” (*irtataqash shaiyi*): the thing was found and joined. There was no gap or hole left in it {T}.

Raghib says “الرَّتْقُ” (*ar-ratq*) means to join whether in creation or artificially.

The Quran has said about the earth and the skies:

21:30	in the beginning this universe was all joined together	كَانَتَا رَتْقًا فَفَتَقْنَاهُمَا
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Then different planets separated from this mass (79:30). The time is the 6th century AD, when nobody could even conceive this. Science has today confirmed this theory. However, at that time this truth could not be related by anyone except God!

“الرَّتْلُ” (*ar-ratal*): teeth that are sparkling white, even and very beautiful. It basically means for something to be very properly balanced or arranged.

“الرَّتْيَلَاءُ” (*ar-rutaila*): a kind of spider which spins a very proportionate and beautiful web {T, M}.

It is said about the Quran:

25:32	We have revealed the best of arrangements, proportion and arrangements.	وَرَتَّلْنَاهُ تَرْتِيلًا
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The Messenger (*pbuh*) has been addressed as:

73:4	You too implement it with that sort of administration and proportion.	وَرَتِّلِ الْقُرْآنَ تَرْتِيلًا
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“الرَّجُّ” (*ar-rajju*): to shake, to shake violently, to cause a sort of quake, to shake something out of its place, to displace it.

“إِرْتَجَّ الْبَحْرُ” (*irtajjal bahr*): the sea became rough.

“الرَّجَاجَةُ” (*ar-rajajah*): the lion's den {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

56:4	when the earth will be shaky due to a violent movement	إِذَا رَجَّصَ الْأَرْضُ رَجًّا
99:1	When the earth will be shaken	إِذَا زُلْزِلَتِ الْأَرْضُ زِلْزَالَهَا

That is, it will be shaken with full force. Such utterances by the Quran could mean physical revolutions as well as social revolutions.

“رَجَزٌ” (*rijz*) and “رُجْزٌ” (*rujz*) both mean continuous unease and permanent movement.

“الرَّجَزُ” (*ar-rajaz*): it’s a kind of camel sickness in which its hind legs or back become so weak that when he tries to get up his legs begin to wobble and he can’t stand up in first two or three attempts {T}.

“رَجَزٌ” (*rijz*) is the permanent unease that a nation suffers and it becomes so weak gradually that it is difficult to stand up again.

34:5	The punishment which gives continuous unease	عَذَابٌ مِنْ رَجَزٍ أَلِيمٌ
29:34	The destruction that comes from external events	رَجْزًا مِنَ السَّمَاءِ

In surah *Al-Airaaaf* such various types of destructions has been termed as “رَجَزٌ” (*rijz*), and that were faced by the nation of the Pharaoh (7:134).

Surah *Al-Anfaal* says that We (in the battlefield of Badr) removed the “رَجَزٌ” (*rijz*) from you that were created by the *shaitaan* (the resistance) and made you stable (8:11). This makes the meaning of “رَجَزٌ” (*rijz*) clear, which is to become unstable, or for such weakness to develop which creates weakness in the hearts and wavering the legs.

In surah *Al-Mudassar* when the Messenger (*pbuh*) was told that “you can now take up this revolutionary cause (invitation) to the people”.

Along with it was said:

74:5	shake off the weakness that produces wavering in the legs	وَالرُّجْزَ فَاهْجُرْ
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Muster up the courage along with your friends to take up such heavy responsibility (of spreading Allah’s message). This surah apparently addresses the Messenger (*pbuh*) but actually, the whole nation is being addressed. Such a revolutionary message (as of God’s supremacy) can only be spread by a group or party that never wavers from its path.

R-J-S

ر ج س

“الرَّجْسُ” (*ar-rijs*): a harsh sound, a big and mixed sound, like an army on the move, or the onrushing of flood or thunder.

“رَجِسَتْ السَّمَاءُ” (*rajatis sama*): the thunder clapped loudly.

“ارْتَجَسَ الْبِنَاءُ” (*artajasil bina’u*): the building moved audibly.

“الرَّجَاسُ” (*ar-rajaaus*): the sea, because it not only has the unease but also noise.

“رِجْسٌ” (*rijs*) means the same as “التباس” (*iltibaas*) i.e. doubt, sixes and seven, unease, not to be one-sided.

“هُم فِي مَرْجُوسَةٍ مِنْ أَمْرِهِمْ” (*hoom fi marjusatin min amrihim*): those people are in doubt over their matter {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means doubt and unease. Dirt is also called “رِجْسٌ” (*rijs*).

The Quran says:

10:100	those who do not employ their intellect and thought, Allah puts filth over them	وَيَجْعَلُ الرِّجْسَ عَلَى الَّذِينَ لَا يَعْقِلُونَ
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Here “رِجْسٌ” (*rijs*) is the result of not using one’s intellect. Therefore the meaning seems obvious i.e. doubt, unease. It also means such matters that are despicable to describe {T}, or unpleasant affairs.

The Quran says that:

5:90	verily intoxication, gambling, sacrifice at alters and diving arrows are abomination from work of the	إِنَّمَا الْخَمْرُ وَالْمَيْسِرُ وَالْأَنْصَابُ وَالْأَزْلَامُ رِجْسٌ مِّنْ عَمَلٍ
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shaitaan	الشَّيْطَانُ
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It shows dislike, execration, unease too. Similarly forbidden edibles are called “فَإِنَّهُ رِجْسٌ” (*fa innahu rijsun*) in 6:146.

“رَجَسَهُ عَنِ الْأَمْرِ” (*rajasahu anil amr*): he stopped him from work {T}. Thus “رِجْسٌ” (*rijs*) are those deeds which create hurdles in the way of human development and which are a hindrance.

Taj-ul-urus says it means those deeds which take man towards destruction.

“مِرْجَاسٌ” (*mirjaas*) means a stone that is made to hang in a well to judge the depth {T}.

Surah *Al-Ahzaab* says about the family of the Messenger (*pbuh*):

33:33	Allah wants to remove rijs from you (Those hindrances that are an obstruction in your development)	يُرِيدُ اللَّهُ لِيُذْهِبَ عَنْكُمُ الرِّجْسَ أَهْلَ الْبَيْتِ
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About those with faith, it is said that their chests open for Islam. Conversely, those who are on the wrong path, their chests are constricted. They pant for breath. After that, it is said:

2:129	Thus places Allah obstructions on those who do not believe	كَذَٰلِكَ يَجْعَلُ اللَّهُ الرِّجْسَ عَلَى الَّذِينَ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ
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This shows that “رِجْسٌ” (*rijs*) means narrowness of the heart, bias, narrow mindedness, dogmatism, not employing one’s intellect and power of reasoning, doubts, unease. All these meanings are included in the connotation. This is why the hypocrites have been called “رِجْسٌ” (*rijsun*) in 9:95. That is, doubts, and being unsure, and obstruction in the right path, as against those with faith (9:124-125).

R-J-Ain ر ج ع

“رُجُوْعٌ” (*ruju*): to turn back and return, to come back {T}.

“رَجْعٌ” (*raj’a*): to turn back.

The meanings in which we [the Urdu-speakers of the sub-continent] use “رَجَعْتُ” (*ruj’at*), is not the right one. We use this word to mean to fall back [retreat]. For somebody to move back from his position or for someone who is re-actionary. This has deterioration, lowliness and falling back in the connotation. However, in the Arabic language, it means to return to the former state, or in a better condition than before.

“الرَّجْعَةُ” (*ar-rajja*) means to re-marry a woman after divorcing her. That is return to the prior state.

“لَيْسَ لِي مِنْ فُلَانٍ رَجْعٌ” (*laisa li fulanin raj’a*): I have had no benefit from that man. That is, nothing ever was returned by him.

The Arabs have a saying: “مَا بَوَّ الْأَسْجَعُ لَيْسَ تَحْتَهُ رَجْعٌ” (*ma huwa illa sajun laisa tahtahu raj’a*). This is only “رَجْعٌ” (*raj’a*) and there is no benefit in it.

“أَرْجَعْتُ الْإِبِلَ” (*arja’atil ibl*) means for a camel to fatten again after becoming weak.

“سَفَرَةٌ مَرْجَعَةٌ” (*safratun marji’ah*): is a journey in which there is some benefit.

“مَتَاعٌ مَرْجَعٌ” (*mata’un murje’un*): very beneficial thing.

“رَجِيٌّ” (*raji*): a rope which has become unraveled but twined again {T}.

“رَجْعٌ” (*raj’a*) means to return, a thing which revolves comes back to the place it travelled from. In this manner, every revolving thing has “رَجْعٌ” (*raj’a*).

Surah *At-Tariq* says:

86:11	the heavenly bodies which are high in the atmosphere are revolving (and return to the place they have	وَالسَّمَاءِ ذَاتِ الرَّجْعِ
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	traveled from)	
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Alternatively, it means the high atmosphere which turn backs (to their starting point) the heavenly bodies or things. And in their revolution, new aspects come forth. In meaning of turning back, this word has appeared in 67:36, where it has come opposite to “مُضِيَّاهُ” (*muziyyah*), which means to go forward.

“رَجَعَ إِلَيْهِ” (*rajal ilaih*) means to turn for help towards, to have recourse to {Lane}.

“رَجَعَ” (*raj'un*) also means reaction and for the results to be formulated.

As such, it is said “رَجَعَ الْعَلْفُ فِي الدَّابَّةِ” (*raja'al alfu fid dabbah*): the effect of the fodder was evident on the animal {T}. “رَجَعَ كَلَامِي فِيهِ” (*raja'a kalami fieeh*): my talk affected him {T}.

“الرَّجْعُ مِنَ الْكَلَامِ” (*ar-rajee-o minal kalami*): the talk which is returned to the speaker {T}.

“رَجْعًا” (*raji'a*) also means hail, because it gives back to the earth what it took from it (water). It also means rain {T}, as well as water which is on a surface {*Kitaab-ul-Ashfaq*}

The Quran says:

86:11	the height that returns vapors to the earth (in the form of rain)	وَالسَّمَاءِ ذَاتِ الرَّجْعِ
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The Quran says “صُمُّ بُكُمْ عُمَىٰ فَهُمْ لَا يَرْجِعُونَ” (*summun bukmun umyun fahum la-yarjioon*) in 2:18. To understand the meaning of “يَرْجِعُونَ” (*yarjioon*) at such places, one thing must be understood as a prelude.

When Messenger **Mohammad (pbuh)** presented his message, there were two sorts of people in front of him. One party was of those with divine Books who at one time were on the right path but had later digressed. They were told to return to the right path. They denied doing so. Secondly, there were those for whom truth had been presented for the very first time. When they refused to come towards the truth, it was said that they do not turn towards the truth, but rather that they do not come to it at all. They do not pay attention towards it.

For this too, the Quran has used the word “لَا يَرْجِعُونَ” (*la yarjeoon*). At the places where this word has appeared, the right translation would be ‘to refer’.

Surah Taha says about **Moosa**:

20:40	We returned you towards your mother	فَرْجَعْنٰكَ إِلَىٰ أُمِّكَ
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Surah **An-Noor** says:

24:28	If the inmate of the house (or the man of the house) tells you to go back, then turn back.	وَإِنْ قِيلَ لَكُمْ اذْجِعُوا فَارْجِعُوا
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The returning of **Yusuf's** brothers to their father has been explained by words like “فَلَمَّا رَجِعُوا إِلَىٰ أَبِيهِمْ” (*falama raja-oo ila*) in 12:63.

Surah **An-Namal** says that when **Suleman** (Solomon) sent his envoy towards **Saba** (**Sheba**), he was told to return after giving her a letter, and not to wait for her reaction. “فَانْظُرْ مَاذَا يَرْجِعُونَ” (*fanzur maaza yarjioon*) 27:28.

In surah **Qaf** the life after death has been called “رَجْعًا” (*rajun*) in 50:3. That is, to return to life after death. Not return to this world but return to life after death in the hereafter.

Here it is necessary to dispel the wrong meaning that might have cropped up in people's minds due to the non-Quranic meaning of “رَجَعْتُ إِلَى اللَّهِ” (*raj'at ilal laah*). When we hear of someone's death, we say “إِنَّا لِلَّهِ” (*inna lillahi wa-inna ilaihi raajioon*), as it appears in 2:156. By this, we mean “**we belong to Allah and will return to Him**”. This leads the mind to make two conclusions. One is that we were with God before being born (into this world) and after death will be gathered in a ground on the Day of the Judgment where God too will be present and thus we will return to Him. This concept is non-Quranic because it confines God to a certain place. This concept is false because God is not confined to a particular place.

He is everywhere - ”هُوَ مَعَكُمْ أَيْنَمَا كُنْتُمْ“ (*hua ma’akum ainama kuntum*) as stated in 57:5. What will be the condition of the life hereafter, how will good deeds be rewarded and bad deeds punished, these are things which cannot be understood in this world.

Whatever the Quran has said in this context shall not be discussed here, but one thing is clear that for the dead to go towards a place where God will be present is not a Quranic concept.

The Quran says:

89:22	Your Sustainer and the malaikah will come row upon row	وَجَاءَ رُكُوكَ وَالْمَلَكُ صَفًّا صَفًّا
89:33	That day jahannnum will be brought.	وَجَائِي يَوْمَئِذٍ بِجَهَنَّمَ

The second situation that arises has been born due to Sufism. Vedant (Hindu Sufism) believes that the human soul is a part of the greater soul (God). This part, after being separating from the whole, has been bogged down and is impatient to join with the whole again. At last, the part will rejoin with the whole as birds return to their nests in the evening. This concept is shared by us in Muslim mysticism.

Virtuous people’s souls will rejoin with their whole (God) and this is the success of life. Such people call death ‘*visaal*’ (reuniting) because they think that a part will shall one day rejoin the whole. This too is a non-Quranic concept because man and God are not part and whole. If a part departs, from a whole then the whole is incomplete and this signifies some fault in God. Therefore this concept cannot be accepted.

The concept of the human soul is wrong as well. For details, see under heading (R-W-H).

The meaning of direction or way is created by ”رَاجِعُونَ“ (*raajioon*) beside ”إِلَيْهِ“ (*ilaih*), or towards Him. Because we consider ”إِلَيْهِ“ (*ilaih*) or ”إِلَيْنَا“ (*ilaina*) to mean direction. Although everywhere in the Quran, it does not mean this.

For example, the Quran says:

	Have you not noted how your Sustainer elongates the shadows	أَلَمْ تَرَ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ كَيْفَ مَدَّ الظَّلَّ
	If He wanted the shadows would neither be elongated or shorten. But he did not do so. He created the sun so that it was the cause of their lengthen in or shortening.	وَلَوْ شَاءَ لَجَعَلَهُ سَاكِنَاتٍ جَعَلْنَا الشَّمْسُ عَلَيْهِ دَلِيلًا

After this it is said:

25:45	then we pull (ilaina) it (the shadow) towards ourselves,	ثُمَّ قَبَضْنَاهُ إِلَيْنَا قَبْضًا يَسِيرًا
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Here the word ”إِلَيْنَا“ (*ilaina*) clearly shows that it does not mean any particular direction but it means that according to the laws of Allah, the shadows become shorter. Therefore, ”إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ“ (*ilaihi raajioon*) may mean to move according to the law of Allah.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:82	Whatever is in the heights or depths of the universe, bows to him, whether it likes it or not	وَلَهُ اسْلَمَ مَنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ طَوْعًا وَكَرْهًا وَإِلَيْهِ يُرْجَعُونَ
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And thus everything is revolving around that centre (of Allah’s laws).

Surah *Yasin* says:

36:83	God’s personality is far beyond man’s concepts of Him. Everything is run by Him	فَسُبْحَنَ الَّذِي يَدِيرُ مَلَكُوتُ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ وَإِلَيْهِ تُرْجَعُونَ
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Therefore, everything moves according to the laws created by Him. Everything operates according to His law, it cannot move away from it, and since man is included in ‘everything’, he too is not an exception to this rule. Every deed of his is tied to the natural chain of events. Thus, every step he takes is going towards Him.

We now go to the natural results of the human world (not the physical universe). In this connection the Quran has several dictums in which “وَالَيْهِ تُرْجَعُونَ” (*wa ilaihi turje-oon*) or similar phrases have been used.

As it is said:

	When a man thinks he needs nobody (is independent of everybody) then he becomes rebellious.	كَأَنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لِرَبِّهِ لَئِطٌ - أَنْ رَأَاهُ اسْتَعْصَمَ
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Although the truth is that no matter how independent he thinks himself to be “إِنَّ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ الرُّجْعُ” (*inna ila rabbikar ruj’aa*) (35:4), he cannot go out of the circle of natural results. He has to come back to this law. This truth has been acknowledged as “وَتَقَطَّعُوا أَمْرَهُمْ بَيْنَهُمْ” (*wataqatta’oo amrahum bainahum*) in 21:93, that is, here every human being is a member of the universal brotherhood. However, for the sake of their own interests they have divided it into many parts. “وَتَقَطَّعُوا أَمْرَهُمْ بَيْنَهُمْ” (*wa taqatahu amrahum bainahum*) as in 21:93.

After that it is said “كُلُّ الْيَتِيمَا رَاجِعُونَ” (*kullun ilaina raaji-oon*), and after that:

21:94	Thus he who stays steadfast on the enabling program and he is also a momin (believer) then his efforts do not stay without result. We keep noting all of them (his efforts)	فَمَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِنَ الصَّالِحَاتِ وَهُوَ مُؤْمِنٌ فَلَا كُفْرَانَ لِسَعْيِهِ وَ إِنَّا لَهُ كَاتِبُونَ
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This explains the meaning of “كُلُّ الْيَتِيمَا رَاجِعُونَ” (*kullun ilaina raajioon*). That is, all efforts of all men produce results according to the laws of Nature that nobody can escape. As the Quran appears to say, “By violating Our orders they think that they are going beyond our grasp, but they are in fact automatically being drawn to Us as per the laws of Nature.” See also 2:281, 2:282 and 6:165, where the meaning of Law of Nature is made explicit.

About the results of deeds, it is generally believed that results will come before us in the life hereafter. This is a wrong notion. The results of deeds start to be compiled along with the commitment of the deeds, and then some results appear in this very life and some in the hereafter.

The Quran says:

29:9	You have to return to Me, then I will let you know about your deeds	إِلَىٰ مَرْجِعِكُمْ فَأُنَبِّئُكُم بِمَا كُنتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ
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It does not mean that when a man stands in front of God after dying, the results of his deeds will appear. It means that all your deeds circle around His laws of Nature, all results are formulated according to them. You cannot remain outside the purview of his laws. And, your results come before you according to it.

The Messenger (*pbuh*) himself was told:

40:78	Some of the punishment which we are promising to the opponents may appear before your eyes too. And it may also possibly be after your death. But sooner or later, their deeds will result according to our law. They cannot go out of its purview.	فَإِمَّا نُرِيَنَّكَ بَعْضَ الَّذِي نَعِدُهُمْ أَوْ نَتَوَفَّيَنَّكَ فَإِلَيْنَا يُرجعون
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But those results which do not appear in this world do appear in the hereafter. This is the place where it has been said that even after death you will “وَالَيْهِ تُرْجَعُونَ” (*ilaihi turjaoon*): will return towards Allah. i.e. do not think that now that you are dead, nobody has a grip on you or you are not accountable to anyone. You will be ruled by the law of Allah even after your death and you cannot escape it. This is the meaning of “وَالَيْهِ تُرْجَعُونَ” (*ilaihi turjaoon*) according to the Quran.

At certain places the word “رُجُوْعٌ” (*ruju*) has appeared to mean what we mean turning towards someone. For example:

36:31	These people do not ruju (refer or turn) to their messengers	أَتُهِمُّ إِلَهُهُمْ لَا يُرْجَعُونَ
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In the light of these clarifications, the right meaning of “إِنَّا إِلَهُهُ رَاجِعُونَ” (*inna ilahi raajeoon*) will now be explained. In the Quran where it is said “إِنَّا إِلَهُهُ رَاجِعُونَ” (*inna ilahi raajeoon*), the verse before it mentions that in the establishment of Allah’s system, there are a lot of difficulties. The difficulties are so extreme that one has to even lay down one’s life in its path. After this the group of *momineen* has been told that you too will face various things. From the opponents or because of the opponents, you will face the fear of oppression, hunger, loss of life and property.

After that it is said:

2:156	Give the news of good results to those, who face such events by saying that one should be ruffled by them.	الَّذِينَ إِذَا أَصَابَتْهُمْ مُصِيبَةٌ قَالُوا إِنَّا لِلَّهِ وَإِنَّا إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ
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Our entire life is dedicated to establishing Allah’s system and we turn to Allah’s laws to be able to meet these challenges. In order to encounter these difficulties successfully, we turn to His laws, or since our entire lives are dedicated to establishing His system, these difficulties cannot make us waver from this path. Besides this, our every step moves towards Him.

Every move of ours revolves around this axis of “إِنَّا إِلَهُهُ رَاجِعُونَ” (*inna ilaihi raa’jeoon*) and the results of our struggle will also be formulated as per His laws on which we have unwavering belief. Let as many difficulties come as they may. Let anyone put as many hurdles in our way as possible. We will not turn away from this path by being frightened or brow beaten. Our every step will in any case move towards this destination, which our God has determined for us and which is the aim and purpose of our lives.

After this, it is said:

2:155-157	these are the people who are congratulated by Allah And these are the people who are on the right path	أَلَيْكَ عَلَيْهِمْ صَلَواتٌ مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ وَرَحْمَةٌ وَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُتَّقُونَ
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These verses make it clear that “إِلَهُهُ رَاجِعُونَ” (*ilahi raa’jeoon*) does not mean that God is at any particular place and we have to return to that place to meet Him. Neither that our soul is a part of that whole (God) and will ultimately reunite with that whole. Instead it means that our entire life is dedicated to Allah’s system “إِنَّا لِلَّهِ” (*inna lillah*), and despite all the difficulties and travails in the world, our steps move towards this very system. It gives us strength and the results of our deeds are formulated according to them. Every move of our lives moves around this axis. It is the centre of our lives. All our efforts are aimed towards this centre. Every deed of ours moves towards the natural cycle of events, and it cannot be detracted. It has to produce a result, whether the result becomes visible in this world or in the hereafter, because His laws are not confined only to this world.

R-J-F

ر ج ف

“الرَّجْفُ” (*ar-rajif*): for something to become mobile, or to shake up. Movement with unease or worry is included in this word’s connotation.

“رَجْفُ الْقَلْبِ” (*rajful qalb*): severe palpitation of the heart due to unease {T, M}.

Raghib says it means severe unease {R}.

“الرَّجْفُ” (*ar-raajif*): fever with shaking.

“رَجَفَتِ الرِّيحُ الشَّجَرَ” (*ar-rajafatir reehush shajar*): the wind shook the trees.

“رَجَفَتِ الْأَرْضُ” (*rajafatil ard*): the earth moved, or shook.

“الرَّجْفَةُ” (*ar-rajfah*): earthquake.

“الْأَرَاكِيفُ” (*ar-rajeef*): instigating news, news that makes one uneasy {T, M}.

The Quran says:

33:60	people who spread news that causes unease or chaos without any reason	الرَّجْفُونَ فِي الْمَدِينَةِ
7:78	They (nation of Samood) were caught (trapped) by the earthquake.	فَأَخَذَتْهُمُ الرَّجْفَةُ
79:6	the day when that which shakes will shake	يَوْمَ تَرْجُفُ الرَّاجِفَةُ
73:14	the day when the common folk will be in an agitated state (the day on which the earth will shake up)	يَوْمَ تَرْجُفُ الْأَرْضُ

“رَجُلٌ” (*rajlu*): foot. Plural is “أَرْجُلٌ” (*arjul*): feet as used in 38:42.
 “رِجَالٌ” (*rijaal*): pedestrian. It is the plural of “رَجُلٌ” (*raajil*), as against “رُكْبَانًا” (*rukbaana*) – ‘mounted’ as in 2:239. It is also used against “خَيْلٌ” (*khail*), which means cavalry (17:64).
 “رَجُلٌ” (*rajul*): man. Plural is “رِجَالٌ” (*rijaal*): people, as used in 2:228 and 72:6.

Muheet says a man is called “رَجُلٌ” (*rajul*) because of his bravery and strength.

Raghib says that the meaning of “رَجُلٌ” (*rajul*) in 36:20, and 40:28 will be of a brave man {T, R, M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically has been derived from a word which means ‘leg’. But “رَجُلٌ” (*rajul*) is different from this meaning.

Ibn Faris says “رَجْمٌ” (*rajm*) basically means to hit with stones, but later it began to mean kill as well. It is also used for accusing or abusing, or to scold and oust.

Taj says it means to leave someone or break relations with someone.

“الرَّجْمُ” (*ar-rajm*) also means to give someone a dressing down {T}.

“الرَّجَامُ” (*ar-rijaam*) means stones, and “مِرْجَامٌ” (*mirjaam*) means a sling which is used to throw stones {Lane}.

Surah *Yasin* says:

36:18	if you do not cease, we will stone you (to death).	لَئِنْ لَمْ تَنْتَهُوا لَنَرْجُمَنَّكُمْ
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Surah *Ash-Shura'a* says:

26:116	You will be among those who are stoned to death or killed	لَتَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْمَرْجُومِينَ
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In surah *Al-Hijr* (15:34-35), the *Shaitaan* (the oppsition) has been called “رَجِيمٌ” (*rajeem*) which has been explained as “إِنَّ عَلَيْكَ اللَّعْنَةَ” (*inna ilaikal la'naa*). As such “رَجِيمٌ” (*rajeem*) and “مَلْعُونٌ” (*mal-oon*) are of the same meaning. For the meaning of “مَلْعُونٌ” (*mal-oon*) see heading (L-Ain-N). It means he who is deprived of God's benevolence, who is distanced from Him, with whom no connection whatsoever is maintained.

“رَجْمٌ” (*rajm*): guess work.

“حَدِيثٌ مُرَجَّمٌ” (*hadeethum- murajjam*) is a thought which cannot be verified {T}.

“رَجَّمَ الرَّجُلُ بِالْغَيْبِ” (*rajjamar rujul bilghaib*): that man has said something about the unknown.

“قَالَهُ رَجْمًا” (*qaalahu rajma*): he simply made a guess {Lane}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says that people who state the number of people in the cave, is only “رَجْمًا بِالْغَيْبِ” (*rajman bilghaib*) that is, mere guessing (18:32). Hence it means that they make guesses without knowing the truth.

In *Lataif-ul-Lugha* too, the meaning of “الرَّجْمُ” (*ar-rajm*) is ‘to guess’.

In the old days, temples had astrologers used to tell people about the unknown. This is still the practice of the priests of temples and religious leaders in religious institutions. They used to claim that they got the news from the heavens. The Quran has said at several places that all this is mere guesswork.

Sometimes something comes true. For instance 2 out of 10 guesses may become true but they have no knowledge about the truth. (15:17-18, 37:69, 67:5, 72:8-9). After the advent of the Quran, the time for knowledge and awareness had arrived. Thus these superstitions had no place in human psyche. Now this nonsense “gets fiery whips by celestial forces”.

As will be disclosed under the heading (L-Ain-N). According to the Quran, “لَعْنَتْ” (*laa’nat*) does not mean demeaning or curse word but a statement of reality. That is, due to the wrong way of life, deprivation from all those delights of life, those are a natural result of living according to the laws of Allah. Anybody who is deprived of these delights will be called “الرَّجْمُ” (*ar-rajm*). This is the meaning of “رَجِيمٌ” (*rajeem*) as well. That is, he who is flung away or who is deprived of the delights, we are told to shun him. Any emotion that obstructs us from the right path or violates the principles of Allah (such people are the *shaitaan*, or the resistance, and must be stayed away from. This is “الرَّجْمُ” (*ar-rajm*) or “رَجِيمٌ” (*rajeem*).

R-J-W

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“الرَّجَاءُ” (*ar-rajaa-u*) means hope, which is the opposite of “يَأْسٌ” (*yaas*). It is a hope that is not faint.

Raghib says this is a hope in which success is expected, but since hope and fear are inevitable together, later it started to be used for ‘hope’ that had fear in the expectation as well.

Muheet says that difference between “أَمَلٌ” (*amalun*) and “رَجَاءٌ” (*rija’un*) is that (*amal*) is used for pleasant hopes but “رَجَاءٌ” *rija* for both good and fretful hopes.

Azhari says when “رَجَاءٌ” (*raja*) is accompanied by a negative word it means fear {*T*}.

Ibn Qateeba too says that “لَا يَرْجُونَ” (*la yarjoon*) means “لَا يَخَافُونَ” (*la yakhafoon*). {*Alqartain* Vol.1}.

Ibn Faris also says that “لَا يَخَافُونَ” (*raja’a*) at times means fear.

“لَا يَخَافُونَ” (*al-irja’a*): to put off for later, to delay, to remove something, to postpone something.

“الرَّجَا” (*ar-rajaa’a*): edge, or edge of a well from top to bottom {*T*}. The plural is “أَرْجَاءٌ” (*arja*) as used in 69:17.

“مَرْجُو” (*marju*): with which hopes are linked (11:62).

“مَرْجُونَ” (*murja-un*): those who are kept waiting, those whose affair is postponed (9:106)

Surah *Ash-Shu’ara* says:

26:36	They said postpone his affair	قَالُوا أَرْجِهْ
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See 7:11 as well. Surah *Al-Ahzaab* says:

33:51	You may defer whom you will of them, or you may take to yourself whom you will.	تُرْجِي مَنْ تَشَاءُ مِنْهُمْ وَتُؤْوِي إِلَيْكَ مَنْ تَشَاءُ
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Here “تُرْجِي” (*turji*) means to keep something back, to remove away, and to put it off towards the edge. “تُؤْوِي” (*tuwi*) means to place close by, near oneself.

“رَحْبَ الشَّيْءِ رَحْبًا” (*rahabas shaiy-u rahba*): to be vast.
 “ارْحَبَهُ” (*arhabah*): he expanded it.

Ibn Faris too thinks that the root has the connotation of vastness or expanse.

“طَرِيقٌ رَحْبٌ” (*tareequn rahb*): broad path.
 “مَرْحَابُكَ” (*marhaba bika*): you came to a vast place, you will be treated here broad mindedly.
 “رَحْبَةٌ” (*rahbah*): the open space in a house {T}.

The Quran says:

9:25	The earth, despite its expansiveness, became narrow for you	وَضَاقَتْ عَلَيْكُمُ الْأَرْضُ بِمَا رَحُبَتْ
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Surah *Saad* says about the dwellers of *jahannum*:

38:10	There is no broad mindedness for you. Nobody welcomes you	لَا مَرْحَبًا بِكُمْ
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In a hellish life, nobody is pleased to see anybody, nobody welcomes a newcomer. Here there is no large heartedness, no lips smile at somebody's arrival. If it is, then it is only artificial, only for the sake of appearances. On the contrary, in their heart everyone is thinking “where did this trouble come from?”

“رَحِيقٌ” (*raheeq*): very old, very pure, unadulterated and excellent wine. Every pure thing is also called “رَحِيقٌ” (*raheeq*).
 “حَسَبُ الرَّحِيقِ” (*hasabur-raheeq*): thoroughbred.
 “مِسْكٌ رَحِيقٌ” (*miskun raheeq*): pure, unadulterated fine perfume {T, M}.

The Quran (83:25) has said about those in *janna* that they shall receive “رَحِيقٌ مَخْلُومٌ” (*raheeqin makhtoom*) which means ‘a pure drink’, such that even later there is no chance of adulteration. Hence, this word means life's pure delights and happiness.

“الرَّحْلُ” (*ar-rahl*): anything that is tied to the camel's back with the intent of sitting in it while traveling.
 “رِحَالٌ” (*rihaal*) is plural of “رَحْلٌ” (*rahl*).
 “الرَّحْلَةُ” (*ar-rihlah*): journey, to the place where one travels to.

With time, this word has also been used for camel, camel seat, or where one alights, or for the house {T, M}. This word is also used for anything which is for loading goods on to the camel's back, or sacks (bags) {T, M}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:62	In their sacks (Bags).	فِي رِحَالِهِمْ
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Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is to keep on travelling or to continue with the journey.

The Quran says:

106:2	The journeys of summer and winter	رِحْلَةُ الشَّيْءِ وَالصَّيْفِ
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“الْمَرْحَلَةُ” (*al-marhalah*): the distance that a man travels habitually towards his destination $\{T\}$.

“رَحْمٌ” (*rihm*), “رَحْمٌ” (*rahm*), “رُحْمٌ” (*ruhm*): the womb of a woman in which a child is nurtured and is protected from external effects {*T, R*}.

“رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) is the gift that completes some shortcoming (and which is given according to the need) {*T*}. It means to gift a thing, which is given without any consideration, as a benevolence. As such, “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) is the sustenance which man gets from God without any cost.

Surah *Ar-Rom* says:

30:36	And when people experience Our benevolence, they start acting up, but when they land in trouble because of their own deeds, they become disappointed	وَإِذَا أَدْقْنَا النَّاسَ رَحْمَةً فَرِحُوا بِهَا وَإِنْ تُصِيبْهُمْ سَيِّئَةٌ بِمَا قَدَّمَتْ أَيْدِيهِمْ إِذَا هُمْ يَنْتَبِهُونَ
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Here “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) has been used against “سَيِّئَةٌ” (*sayyia*). Therefore, it would mean all the delights of life. But the next verse mentions vastness or expanse, or large heartedness. It is obvious then that here “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) means the goods or accoutrements of life which we get from God without asking and at no cost.

In surah *Bani Israel*, the longing for parents by their progeny is mentioned:

17:24	O God, look after them (nurture them) as they brought me up in childhood	وَقُلْ رَبِّ ارْحَمْهُمَا كَمَا رَبَّيْنِي صَغِيرًا
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“رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) also means rain which produces sustenance from earth (30:46, 42:28). Life’s delights (“نِعْمَاءٌ” - *na’maa*) which we get from God without any charge, are also “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*), as in 11:9-10.

In the tale about *Moosa*, it is mentioned that the treasure belonging to two orphan kids was buried under a wall, which had been so buried as to be discovered by them when they became adults. This arrangement by God is called “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) in 18:82.

“رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) also means to cover something or to provide with the means of protection {*T*}. That is why the noble Quran has used “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) against “ضَرَرٌ” (*zarar*) which means ‘harm’ (30:33, 10:21), and against “سَيِّئَةٌ” (*sayyia*) (30:31) and against “أَهْلَاكَ” (*ahlaka*) (67:28).

Since God’s sustenance is not only for a man’s physical being, instead, it is also for human personality’s development, which is the product of the life’s order which Revelation gives us, therefore Revelation has also been called “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*) in 43:23, 2:105. The truth which is the biggest source of man’s development is the revelation which is totally given by God, which is why it is a special “رَحْمَةٌ” (*rahmah*).

Since God is “رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ” (*rabbil aalameen*), or the one who provides development of the entire universe and develops the human personality as well, therefore He has taken upon Himself to provide Revelation through His Own sources.

6:54	Your Sustainer has taken upon Himself to provide the means of Sustenance without failure.	كَتَبَ رَبُّكُمْ عَلَى نَفْسِهِ الرَّحْمَةَ
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Thus, He covers the entire universe in His blanket of benevolence (40:7). This is why in surah *Al-Fateha*, along with “رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ” (*rabbil aalameen*) also says “الرَّحْمَنُ الرَّحِيمُ” (*ar-rahman-ir-raheem*).

“رَحِيمٌ” (*raheem*) means linguistically one who provides means of sustenance on continuous basis. “رَحْمَنٌ” (*rahman*), on the other hand, is one who provides means of sustenance at a time of great need with overwhelmingness {*Al-Minar*}.

The first can be said to be an evolutionary means of provision of sustenance, while the second as an emergent provision.

Surah *Ar-Rahman* says:

55:29	Whatever there is in the heavens and on earth, is dependant on God for its sustenance	يَسْأَلُهُ مَنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ كُلَّ يَوْمٍ هُوَ فِي شَأْنٍ
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These things do not stay in one state and do not require the same sort of sustenance always. They keep changing with time. Thus, their demands for nourishment change as well with time. The needs of a foetus inside a mother's womb are quite different from the demands of bringing up a kid, and again for an adult, quite different. As long as something stays in a state, its sustenance is done by God's kindness in a certain way. But as soon as it changes, its sustenance changes as well according to God's law. Thus in this way, everything reaches its completion from its beginning. This is the meaning of *Rabb, Rahman* and *Raheem*.

“رَحْمٌ” (*rihm*) also means kith and kin, relatives {*T, R, M*}.

“بَيْنَهُمَا رَحْمٌ” (*bainahuma rihm*): those two are closely related.

“أَرْحَامٌ” (*ar-haam*) is the plural of “رَحْمٌ” (*rihm*) (3:5) which also means relatives (60:3, 2:1).

“أُولُوا الْأَرْحَامِ” (*oolu al arhaam*): relatives (8:75).

Since “رَحْمٌ” (*rihm*) involves softness, therefore it also means that.

48:29	very hard against the opponents and very soft against each other	أَشِدَّاءُ عَلَى الْكُفَّارِ رُحَمَاءُ بَيْنَهُمْ
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Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:81	one who gives relations a big consideration	أَقْرَبُ رُحْمًا
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But *Ibn Faris* says that “أَرْحُمٌ” (*ar-ruhm*) and “الرَّحْمَةُ” (*ar-rahmah*) are of the same meaning. This will make the meaning as one who is extra kind, extra sympathetic and faithful. *Ibn Faris* says it basically means softness and leaning.

Christians believe that every human child is born as a consequence of the sins of the parents and since this sin cannot be more than the deeds, therefore a man can be delivered only with God's mercy. This concept of mercy is against the Quranic teachings. According to the Quran, success is the natural result of deeds, and all this takes place according to the divine laws which are called the laws of nature.

The basic principle of these laws is that:

53:39	a man gets (in return) whatever he does	لَيْسَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ إِلَّا مَا سَعَى
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This means that good results for good deeds and bad results for bad deeds. Although for such deeds various capabilities are received by man as also guidance from God, free of cost, and these are included in “رَحْمٌ” (*rahm*). That is, all this for the development of man is received from God, free of cost.

Now the man, who benefits from these things and develops his personality according to the laws of God, will be the beneficiary of life's blessings. He, who will not do so, will be deprived of them. This is the law of God (Nature). Therefore, man can reach his ultimate destiny, not due to the mere benevolence of God, but because of the result of his own deeds, in accordance with the laws of God. Based on this fundamental principal, Quran modifies such a nation that creates a heavenly society for itself with its utter most dedication.

“رَحْمَنٌ” (*rahman*) rhymes with “فَعْلَانٌ” (*fa'lan*), as “تَطْشَانٌ” (*tatshan*) to “غَصْبَانٌ” (*ghasban*), while “رَحِيمٌ” (*raheem*) rhymes with “فَعِيلٌ” (*fa'eel*), as “عَلِيمٌ” (*aleem*) with “حَكِيمٌ” (*hakeem*) etc. “فَعْلَانٌ” (*fa'lan*) is used for qualities which are intense and of emergent, and “فَعِيلٌ” (*fa'eel*) which are a must and continuous.

“الرَّخْوُ” (*ar-rikhwu*): soft thing.
 “رَخَوُ الشَّيْءُ” (*rakhush shaiyi*), “رَخِيَ” (*rikhi*), “رَخَا” (*rakha*): for something to become soft or loose.
 “اِسْتَرَخَى” (*istarkha*) also means the same as above.
 “ارْخَاهُ” (*arkhah*), “رَاخَاهُ” (*rakhah*): he made him soft.
 “ارْخَى دَابَّتَهُ” (*arkha dabbatah*): he left the animal loose and let it have its way.
 “الرُّخَاءُ” (*ar-rukha*): softened the speed {T, R, M}.

The Quran says:

38:36	The (wind) used to blow softly and freely on His order	تَجْرِي بِأَمْرِ رُخَاءٍ
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“فَرَسٌ رِخْوَةٌ” (*faras-un rikhwah*): speedy and soft natured horse {T, R, M}.

“الرِّدَّةُ” (*ar-ridu*): heavy loads which are equal to each other in weight.
 “رَدَّ الشَّيْءَ” (*radish shaiyi bihi*): he boosted something with something, supported it, helped it.

Actually, “الرِّدَّةُ” (*arid-u*) means helper {T}. When an animal is laden with weight on both sides in such a manner that both sides weigh the same, then each load is called “رِدَّةٌ” (*rid-un*). When loads on each side are of the same weight, they support each other to maintain balance {T}.

The Quran says:

28:34	send him as my helper	فَأَرْسَلْهُ مَعِيَ رِدْءًا
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“رَدِيٌّ” (*radi-un*): one who follows, but later it came to mean a condemned thing {R}, because generally that which comes behind is something with a fault.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings, which are almost opposite. He says it means for something to deteriorate or become bad, and secondly to help.

“رَدَدَ” (*rud*), “يَرُدُّ” (*yarud*): to return (something) to somebody.

If it is followed by “عَلَى” (*ala*), then it has an element of insult and demeaning.
 “رَدَّ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*radda a'laihi-shai'i*): he turned his back on that thing.

But if it is followed by “إِلَى” (*ila*), then it has the elements of respect, but it is not a principle

28:13	We returned Moosa honorably to his mother	فَرَدَدْنَاهُ إِلَىٰ أُمِّهِ
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“الرُّدُّ” (*ar-rud*) means garbage.
 “دِرْهَمٌ رُدٌّ” (*dirham rudd*): coin.
 “لَا مَرَدَّةَ فِيهِ” (*la maraddata feeh*): it has no return (profit).
 “إِرْتَدَّ الشَّيْءُ” (*irtadd ash shaiyi*): the thing returned, went back {T}.

Raghib says that “الَارْتِدَادُ” (*la-irtidaad*) means returning by the same path that one has come by.

“تَرَدَّدَ إِلَيْهِ” (*taraddada ilaih*): he came to him and returned repeatedly.

“تَرَدَّدَ فِي الْأَمْرِ” (*taraddad fil amr*): to be undecided on something {R}

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says:

2:228	Their husbands have more right to take them back	وَيُعَوِّذُهُنَّ أَحَقُّ بِرَدِّهِنَّ
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The Quran says:

42:47	the day which will not go away (which cannot be avoided or returned	يَوْمٌ لَا مَبْرَدَ لَهُ
19:76	beneficial in the end, as a result	خَيْرٌ مَرَدًّا
42:44	Can there be some way in which it will turn back?	هَلْ إِلَى مَرَدٍّ مِنْ سَبِيلٍ

“فَرَدُّوا أَيْدِيَهُمْ فِي أَقْوَابِهِمْ” (*faraddu aidiyahum fee afwaahihim*) as in 14:9. For the meaning of this verse, see heading (Y-D-Y).

This word has the connotation of ‘at last’. Therefore, it is used generally for the result of deeds.

Surah **As-Sajdah** says:

41:47	When the revolution shall take place, is known to none other than Allah	إِلَيْهِ يُرَدُّ عِلْمُ السَّاعَةِ
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We have to return to Him, and no one else. Only He knows how and where. Others can only make guesses. See heading (S-W-Ain).

“مَرْدُودٌ” (*mardood*): that which has been turned back, returned (79:10).

Surah **Hoodh** says:

11:77	Chastisement which cannot be turned back or returned	عَذَابٌ غَيْرُ مَرْدُودٍ
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A verse in surah **An-Nahal** relates one of the basic principles of the system of sustenance of the Quran. God has said in it that different people have different capabilities for earning, due to which the different sectors in society run. This has been explained further in (43:23). See heading (S-K-R). But this does not mean that those who have capability to acquire more sustenance keep that which they acquire to themselves. That is, they should not believe that they have acquired it because of their capability and hence they should be the owners of it, regardless their need. This is a wrong concept.

16:71	Those who have received this excess capability do not let the sustenance reach those who are downtrodden. They fear that they will become holders of equal shares (despite their lesser capabilities)	فَمَا لِلَّذِينَ فَضَّلُوا بَرَادًى رِزْقِهِمْ عَلَى مَا مَلَكَتْ أَيْمَانُهُمْ فَهُمْ فِيهِ سَوَاءٌ
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“بَرَادًى” (*biraddi*) here is notable. The verse did not say that eyes should be given as alms. What is said is that the excess sustenance is for those who need it and are under them (the strong people). Therefore, the sustenance should be turned towards them. If you do not do this, it would mean that you think that the power or capacity for earning is not granted by God, or that you have received it from God, free of cost.

16:71	Do these people, who do not return their excess wealth to those who are needy, deny God’s benevolence?	أَفَبِنِعْمَةِ اللَّهِ يَجْحَدُونَ
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This is Quran’s social order. (Details will be found in my book ‘*Nizaam-i-Raoobiyat*’).

“الرَّادِفُ” (*ar-radif*), “الرَّادِيفُ” (*ar-radeef*): one who rides double behind a rider. Similarly, anything that is behind another is called so as well.

“رَدِيفٌ” (*radifah*) and “رَدَفٌ” (*radafah*): to come behind something {T}.

The Quran says:

27:72	Perhaps it is approaching behind you	عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَكُونَنَّ رَدِفٌ لَّكُمْ
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This means, is very near you. It can also mean that it may have followed you.

“مُرْدِفٌ” (*murdif*): to make someone ride behind, and one who follows somebody {T}.

“مِنْ الْمَلَائِكَةِ مُرْدِفِينَ” (*minal malaiki murdifeen*): those who come one after the other, continuously (8:9).

“رَادِفٌ” (*raadif*): one who comes behind, or close up on you.

“تَتَّبِعُهَا الرَّادِفَةُ” (*tatba-uhar raadifah*): the follower will follow him (79:7). That is the moment of reward and punishment, or God’s law of natural results, the time for the results to appear, the result of deeds which follows inevitably.

Raghib says that “الرَّامِدُ” (*al-murdif*) means the rider in front who lets somebody ride behind him.

“الرَّادِمُ” (*ar-ridm*): to close some gap or hole. “سَدٌّ” (*sadda*) is its alternate, but “رَدَمٌ” (*radm*) is somewhat stronger than “سَدٌّ” (*sadd*).

“رَدَمَ الْبَابَ” (*radamal baab*): to close the door, to shut one third of it {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to close some gap with some sort of barrier.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:94	They said “O Dhulqarnain, indeed Yajooj and Majooj are corrupters in this land. We would like to make a request to you that you create a barrier (<i>sadda</i>) between us and them.	قَالُوا يَا ذَا الْقُرْنَيْنِ إِنَّ يَأْجُوجَ وَمَأْجُوجَ مُفْسِدُونَ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَهَلْ جَعَلْ لَكَ خَرْجًا عَلَىٰ أَنْ تَجْعَلَ بَيْنَنَا وَبَيْنَهُمْ سَدًّا
18:95	(He said) I will make a strong barrier (<i>radma</i>) between you and them.	أَجْعَلْ بَيْنَكُمْ وَبَيْنَهُمْ رَدْمًا

“رَدَىٰ” (*radaa*) and “تَرَدَّى” (*taradasa*): he fell into the well. “رَدَدَى” (*raddi*) is also used in this meaning. It may also mean that he fell from the mountain and died {T}.

92:11	When he will fall head over heels in the jahannum (state of destructions) his accumulated wealth will do him no good	مَا يُغْنِي عَنْهُ مَالُهُ إِذَا تَرَدَّى
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Raghib says that “تَرَدَّى” (*taradda*) means to present you to destruction. That means, he who accumulates wealth and does not use it for the benefit of mankind calls in a way on forces of destruction to come his way.

“الْمُتَرَدِّيةُ” (*al-mutaraddiyah*): an animal which falls to death. It has been declared by the Quran as forbidden for eating (5:3). Thereafter the word also means death in the ordinary sense.
 “رَدِي فُلَانٌ” (*raddi falanun*): he was killed.
 “فَهُوَ رَدِي” (*fahuwarid*): he is to be killed.
 “أَرَدَاهُ غَيْرُهُ” (*ardahu ghairahu*): he was killed by someone {T}.
 “الرَّادِي” (*ar-radaa*): destruction, annihilation {R}.
 “الرَّادَاءُ” (*ar-radaa’u*): sheet of cloth to cover oneself, especially the one used by Muslim women.

Surah *Taha* says “فَتَرَدَّى” (*fatardaa*): may you be annihilated or killed (20:16)
 Surah *As-Sajdah* says: “أَرَدَاكُمْ” (*ardaakum*): to destroy and destruct (41:23).
 “الْمَرْدِيُّ” (*al-mardiyyo*): a thrown stone {T}.

Ibn Faris says the root basically means to throw. He says that “الْتَرَدَّى” (*at-taraddi*) means to go to one’s death playfully.

“رَادَى عَنِ الْقَوْمِ” (*raada unil qaum*): he threw stones in defense of the nation {T}.
 For the meaning of “رَدَّةٌ” (*rid-un*), see heading (R-D-A).

R-Dh-L ر ذ ل

“الرَّذْلُ” (*ar-razl*): a thing which is not liked or disliked for its uselessness {R}.
 “الرَّذْلُ” (*ar-razl*), “الرَّذَالُ” (*ar-ruzal*), “الرَّذِيلُ” (*ar-razeel*): a man who is of lower stature than others, i.e. a man of low stature {T}. It also means garbage, or something out of which the good things have been extracted, and the useless things are left behind {M}.
 “الرَّذْلُ” (*al-arzal*): very lowly, cheap and useless. Plural is “الرَّذُلُونَ” (*arzaloon*).

The Quran says that the leaders of the nation of Nooh told him that the people who have joined his group were “بُنُى أَرَاذِلُنَا” (*hum arazilona*), meaning that they are people of lower class (11:27).
 “أَرَذَلَ الْعُمُرُ” (*arzalil umur*): the fag end of life (16:70), or that part of old age.
 “لَا يَعْلمُ بَعْدَ عِلْمٍ” (*la ya’lama baada ilm*): the age when a man forgets even things which he once knew, i.e. when he becomes senile.

R-Z-Q ر ز ق

“رِزْقٌ” (*rizq*): anything from which benefit can be derived, or the sustenance that living beings get from God. Rain is “رِزْقٌ” (*rizq*), and so is a fixed income. Therefore, “مُرْتَزِقَةٌ” (*murtaziqa*) are those people who have fixed salaries, ration or allowances. “رِزْقَةٌ” (*razqah*) is the ration which soldiers get {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to give something at a fixed time. Thereafter the word began to be applied to every gift without regard to any time.

The Quran has termed all edibles as “رِزْقُ اللَّهِ” (*rizqullah*), or Allah’s *rizq* (2:60). In surah *Al-Hijr* “مَعَايِشَ” (*ma’ayish*) and “رِزْقٌ” (*rizq*) have been used in similar meaning (15:20), but for the Quran, life is not only man’s physical life but this existence continues (in another form) even after death. That means that development is not only needed for the nurturing of the physical being but also for man’s personality. Therefore the Quran has termed these means of sustenance even after death as “رِزْقٌ” (*rizq*) (22:58). This also shows that life in heaven is one of the evolutionary stages of life. There too, human life will continue to be developed. Details can be found in heading (J-N-N).

Thus, “رِزْقٌ” (*rizq*) is those means of sustenance which are required for the development of Man’s physical being as well as his personality. The truth is that if the distribution of life’s necessities takes

place according to the law stated by Revelation, which is called the system of **Raboobiyah** or welfare, then a man's personality and his body can develop effortlessly.

Such a system is established by those about whom it is said:

2:3	whatever means of sustenance We give them, they keep available for humanity at large	وَمَا رَزَقْنَاهُمْ يُنْفِقُونَ
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This means that they do not collect it for themselves, nor do they block them (again for themselves). They keep them open. See heading (N-F-Q). Since this system is in obedience of Allah's laws, therefore it has been said:

17:31	it is Us who give this rizq	لَحْنُ نَزَقْنَاهُمْ وَإِيَّاهُمْ
2:152	We give rizq to you as well as to your progeny	

In this way it is the responsibility of the establishment based upon Allah's laws to provide for every individual citizen (11:6), otherwise, if the division of **rizq** is according to man-made laws then (as we witness in the world today) millions of people die of starvation. There are further millions who are unable to feed themselves and their families properly. In the wrong sort of society there is hoarding, and the lower class is deprived of the means of sustenance. In a right kind of (Quranic) society, all sources of sustenance are available for everybody (41:10), because whatever is produced employs only man's labor. Everything else happens according to the law of Allah.

Therefore Man has right only to the remuneration for his labor. All the rest belongs to Allah, therefore it should be distributed according to His laws (56:64-73). Details will be found in my book **Nizam-e-Rabhoobiyyat** where this division of sustenance has been dealt with from different angles.

The government which is established to enforce the laws of Allah is called an Islamic government. The basic principle of which is that the responsibility for providing every individual with the necessities of life rests with the state. In such a system, the fountainheads of sustenance are owned not by individuals but by the state and nobody has extra wealth. Therefore, every person works hard. He keeps what is needed for him and gives the rest for the sustenance of others. Thus, the state can fulfill the responsibility of providing for every individual. The purpose of an Islamic government is to distribute the sustenance given by God according to His laws among people who follow his laws.

Surah **Al-Waaqia** says “وَتَجْعَلُونَ رِزْقَكُمْ” (*wataja 'aloona rizqakum*) in 56:82. **Raghib** says that here it means luck or share, but the clear meaning is that you deny a book like the Quran, just so you may maintain your hegemony and keep your earning intact!

R-S-Kh ر س خ

“رَسَخَ” (*rasakha*), “يَرْسُخُ” (*yarsukhu*), “رُسُوخًا” (*rusukha*): for something to be solid in its place.
 “رَسَخَ الْمَطَرُ” (*rasakhal mataru*): the rainwater was absorbed in the ground {T}. This is said when the water has gone so deep as to reach the ground's dampness.

The Quran has said:

3:6	the people who deeply imbibe knowledge (who become mature in knowledge)	الرَّاسِخُونَ فِي الْعِلْمِ
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Raghib says “رَاسِخٌ فِي الْعِلْمِ” (*raasikhul fil ilm*) is one who has done so much research as to leave no doubt about the findings {T}.

The Quran presents its invitation or message on the basis of intellect and insight, and stresses on accepting it on the basis of deliberation and knowledge and research. Thus “رَاسِخٌ فِي الْعِلْمِ” (*raasikhul fil ilm*) is one who reaches the truth of the results with research and thus his belief on God becomes solid.

For the meaning of verse, 3:6 see heading (H-K-M).

R-S-S

ر س س

“الرَّسُّ” (*ar-rus*): to dig, to bury. That is why to bury a dead man is also called “رَسٌّ” (*rus*). It also means an old well, whether paved or unpaved.

“الرَّسُّ” (*ar-rus*) also means the beginning of something.

“رَسَّ الْحُمَى وَرَبَّيْنَهُ” (*russul huma wa raseesah*): the initial indications of fever, such as yawning etc. {T}.

Raghib says it means the little effect that is present in something.

“أَهْلُ الرَّسِّ” (*ahlu-rus*): people who fabricate a lie first and then propagate it.

This has been derived from “رُ” (*rusa bainal qaum*): to create chaos and enmity {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means ‘to solidify’.

The Quran says “أَصْحَابُ الرَّسِّ” (*as-habar-rus*) in 25:38. It has been used for some nation beside nations of *Aad* and *Thamood*. There are quite a few stipulations about it in the dictionary. One is that “الرَّسُّ” (*ar-rus*) is the name of a valley. Maybe this name was given to it due to some old well in this valley. {R}.

But if figurative meaning is taken then it would mean that nation which used to fabricate wrong sort of talk and created chaos or unease among their people. Or, it was a nation with very little effect of their messengers left in them.

R-S-L

ر س ل

“رِسْلٌ” (*risl*) means for an obstruction to be removed and for a thing to proceed ahead smoothly with peace and ease {R}.

“رِثَاقَةُ رَسْلَةٍ” (*naaqatun raslah*): slow camel.

“إِبِلٌ مَرَاسِيْلٌ” (*ibl maraseel*): slow camels.

“رَسُولٌ” (*rasool*): one who gets going, one who departs. Sometimes “رَسُولٌ” (*rasul*) is used to mean to get going. {R}.

“عَلَى رِسْلِكَ” (*ala rislik*): live peacefully as you want.

“الرَّسْلُ” (*ar-rasl*): slow in speed.

“الْإِسْتِرْسَالُ” (*al-istirsaal*): slowness in the animal’s speed.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to get going. A group or herd is also called “الرَّسْلُ” (*ar-rasl*)

“جَاءَتْ الْخَيْلُ أَرْسَالًا” (*ja’atil khailu arsaala*): horses came in groups

“الْإِرْسَالُ” (*al-irsaal*): to send (towards somebody)

“أَرْسَلَهُ عَلَيْهِ” (*arsalahu alaihi*): he imposed himself on someone.

“الرَّسُولُ” (*ar-rasul*): the person who is sent towards men from God, as well as the message he conveys.

“رَسُولٌ” (*rasul*), “رِسَالَةٌ” (*risaalah*) and “مُرْسَلٌ” (*mursal*) appears for both messenger and the message itself {T}.

“الْتَرَسِيْلُ فِي الْقِرَاءَةِ” (*at-tarseelu fi alqira’ah*): to read slowly and beautifully {T}.

“الرَّسُولُ” (*ar-rasul*) would mean a person who gives the message from his sender continuously, gradually and with softness. His message too is called “الرَّسُولُ” (*ar-rasul*).

Men who got revelation from God and took it to the people are called Allah's "الرَّسُولُ" (*ar-rasul*). The Quran has called them "النَّبِيَّاءُ" (*ambia*), as well as "رُسُلٌ" (*rusul*). There is no difference between a *nabi* and a *rasul*.

Nabuwwa is to get the revelation from God and *risala* means to take it forward to the people. The details will be found under heading (N-B-A) where it has been clarified that the belief that a *nabi* is without *sharia* and *rasul* is with a *sharia*, is false. The Quran has made no such distinction. Every *nabi* had a holy book (2:213) and every "*rasul* did so as well (57:25).

As said above, a *rasul's* duty is to take Allah's message that he gets through Revelation, to the people.

Nooh told his nation that he was a *rasul* of Allah:

7:62	I bring you the messages from my Sustainer	أُبَلِّغُكُمْ رِسَالِ رَبِّي
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About *Muhammed* it is said:

5:67	Whatever that has been revealed to you by your Sustainer, take it to others	بَلِّغْ مَا أُنْزِلَ إِلَيْكَ مِنْ رَبِّكَ
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As such, whatever *Muhammed (pbuh)* had received from God, he conveyed to people himself. He did not leave this task to others.

Rasul, who were selected to take Allah's message to the people, were human beings (18:110) and they were all men (16:43, 12:09, 21:7). *Rasul* was the first believer of the revelation that it was from God and was the truth (2:285). He was also the first member of this group (believers), that is, he would be the first member of the party that he would organize for establishing Allah's laws on this earth (40:66). He himself was a follower of the revelation and used to strive for establishing a system for practical life based on its teachings (4:64). He would never ask anyone to follow his own orders (and not that of Allah). Nor was this sort of things befitting for a messenger, such as to make people obey his own orders instead of Allah's (3:78-79). Thus obeying *rasul* was in a way obedience of Allah's orders (4:80), therefore this obedience was the obedience of the system which was established for implementing Allah's laws on this earth.

The revelation ended with *Muhammad (pbuh)*, and thereafter followed the system which was established under the Quranic laws.

In this system, the successor (*khilifa*) of the *Rasul* performed the duties, which the messenger (pbuh) performed in his lifetime. That is, obeying Allah's laws and inducing others to follow them as well. But this system of following *Allah and Rasul* did not last very long. If that system is established once again, then that obedience can be established as well. This shall be equivalent to following Allah and *Rasul* in practical terms. These matters have been explained in my book "*Islami Nizaam*" (Islamic System), where it is said that *Allah and Rasul* have been mentioned together at many places in the Quran. But after that, the pronoun used is singular. It means that obedience to *Allah and Rasul* are not two different obediences, but the same. What is meant by them is the obedience to Allah's laws which is done by following the system established by the *Rasul* and which after his death is carried on by his followers.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that "الرَّسُولُ" (*ar-rasul*) also means a fellow archer although *Lissaanul Arab* says that the word "رَسُولٌ" (*raseel*) means this, but not "رَسُولٌ" (*rasul*). But Allah and His *rasul* are in fact fellow archers, because Allah's orders are implemented in this world by the strength of the *rasul* and his companions or followers.

That is why that at the time of the battle of *Badr*, God had said that:

8:17	it was not you who was shooting the arrows, but God himself	وَمَا زَيَّيْتُ إِذْ رَمَيْتَ وَلَكِنَّ اللَّهَ رَمَى
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This is the closeness between God, His **rasul** and his companions and followers that brings into force the system of Allah. More details about this can be found in “قَابَ قَوْسَيْنِ” (*qaaba qauseen*) (53:9). See heading (Q-W-S).

As mentioned earlier, **nabi** and the **rasul** are two sides of the same coin. That is why the characteristics related by the Quran of a **nabi** do not differ from that of a **rasul**.

Note. There are letters about the obedience of **rasul** in “*Letters to Saleem* - vol. II”

For confirmation of this, view the many places where the characteristics of a **rasul** or **nabi** are defined in the Quran. For example, a **rasul** never orders anyone to follow his personal commandments, but only wants you to obey the laws of Allah (3:78). If he makes some mistake, then that is personal fault (not Allah’s). He shows the right path in the light of Revelation (34:50). A **rasul** does not have the power even for his own good or bad (10:49). He never asks anyone to compensate him for the messenger-hood (10:72). **Rasuls** also had wives and children (13:38). All **rasul** came in their respective times and died as well (3:143), but after the advent of **Muhammad (pbuh)**, deliverance can only be obtained by following his dictum (7:158). **Rasul** always appeared in central places (28:59). Before getting into messenger-hood, the **rasul** were totally unaware that they would get such a task. (42:82, 28:89). Messenger **Muhammad** was illiterate before becoming a messenger, not afterwards (29:48). Messenger **Muhammad (pbuh)** was Allah’s last **rasul** (33:41), therefore no **nabi** or **rasul** can come now. **Rasul** only guided to the path of God, made others to follow it, but to make that happen was not in their power or their responsibility (28:56). To have trust in some messenger and to disbelieve others is **kufir** (denial) (4:150). These traits or characteristics and others have been ascribed to **rasuls** and **nabis** at different places in the Quran. This too has been said that (supposing) if the **rasuls** made any changes or amendments to the revelations, then they would face consequences as well as others. (17:74, 11:113, 10:5, 68:9).

Since the Quran is a complete code of life and since God has guaranteed its protection, the guidance of the human race does not end with the messenger-hood coming to an end. The question is of establishing the same system of God which the Messenger **Muhammad (pbuh)** had established. This system can be reestablished even today.

“إِرْسَالٌ” (*irsaal*) means to leave or let go.

“أَرْسَلَ الْخَيْلَ فِي الْغَارَةِ” (*arsalal khail fil gharah*): reigns of the horses were let loose in the attack {T, M}.

The Quran has used this word to mean the opposite of “إِمْسَاكٌ” (*imsaak*) which means to restrain.

“أَرْسَلَ عَلَى” (*arsala ala*): to impose on someone (19:83).

R-S-W

ر س و

“رَسَالَتِي يَرْسُو” (*rasash shaiyi yarsu*), “أَرْسَى” (*arsa*), “إِرْسَاءٌ” (*irsaah*): for something to come to rest, to become immovable.

“رَسَتْ السَّفِينَةُ تَرْسُو” (*rasatis safaeenatau tarsu*): the boat anchored {T, M}.

“أَرْسَى السَّفِينَةَ” (*arsas safinah*): anchored the boat, made it stop.

“الْمِرْسَاةُ” (*al-mirsaah*): a boat’s anchor {T, M}.

“مَجْرِيَا وَمَرْسَاهَا” (*majriha wa mursaaha*): for a boat to sail and anchor (11:41).

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:187	When shall it happen? When will it come before us?	أَيَّانَ مَرْسِيَا
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“مَرْسَى” (*mursa*) can mean both the time to stop, as well as the stopping place.

“قُدُورِ رَاسِيَاتٍ” (*qudurir raasiyaat*): big cooking pots which are strongly fixed at one place (32:13).

“رَوَاسِي” (*rawasi*): fixed mountains (13:3). Singular is “رَاسِيَةٌ” (*raasia*).

“رَشَدٌ” (*rashad*), “يُرْشِدُ” (*yarshud*), “رُشْدًا” (*rushda*), “رَشِيدٌ” (*rashid*), “يُرْشِدُ” (*yarshad*), “رَشْدَانًا” (*rashadan*), “رَشَادًا” (*rashada*): the right solution of a matter, or to find the right path {T, M}.
 “الرُّشْدُ” (*ar-rushd*): to be firmly on the right path {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says it means to firmly adopt a path.

“الرَّشْدُ” (*ar-rashadu*), “الرُّشْدُ” (*ar-rushdu*): the opposite of “غَيٌّ” (*ghayyio*), and is used to mean the right guidance {R} (2:256).

Surah *An-Nisa* has used “رُشْدًا” (*roshda*) in 4:6, which means the ability to get to the bottom of things, or mature intellect.

“إِسْتَرْشَدَ فُلَانٌ لِأَمْرِهِ” (*istarshada fulanun li-amrihi*): that man found the right solution to his problem.

“أَرْشَدْتُهُ” (*arshadtuhu*): I guided him to the right path.

“الرَّشِيدُ” (*ar-rasheed*): one who shows the right way (11:87), and also a person who can judge things rightly or whose estimates can reach their climax without any help or failure {T}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:10	that the young men prayed to God, for them to be benevolent in the revolutionary struggle and to guide them on the right path	وَهَيَّئْ لَنَا مِنْ أَمْرِنَا رَشَدًا
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After this it is said:

18:16	your benefactor will also give you the goods of His benevolence (And will also facilitate the successful completion of purpose)	وَيُهَيِّئْ لَكُمْ مِنْ أَمْرِكُمْ مَرْفَاقًا
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This shows that “رَشَادًا” (*rashada*) means not only to guide towards the right path but also to provide the tact and ease for reaching the destination successfully.

“الْمَرَشِيدُ” (*al-marashid*) are the ways which lead to the destination. In the Quran, “رَشَادًا” (*rashada*) has been used against ضرر (*darru* – ‘loss’ (72:21). Thus “رُشْدًا” (*rooshd*) is a composite word which involves the tact and all measures to avoid loss on the way. That is why the messengers (i.e. those people who used to invite towards God) had been given “رُشْدًا” (*rooshd*) (21:51), and the group of *momineen* was called “رَاشِدُونَ” (*raashedoon*) (49:7). All this is received by obeying Allah’s laws. That is why the Quran has made it clear that there is no “وَلِيٌّ” *wali* nor “مُرْشِدٌ” (*murshid*) except Allah (18:17), but we still consider some human beings as our religious leaders, or holy men, and hence are suffering because of that too!

Ibn Faris says its root basically means to lie in ambush.

“رَصَدَهُ” (*rasadah*): he waited for him.

“الرَّاصِدُ” (*ar-rasid*): one who waits and watches the movements of someone.

“الرَّصِيدُ” (*ar-raseed*): a wild animal that lies in wait to attack {T}.

“إِرْصَادٌ” (*irsaad*): to wait and while waiting, to prepare {T}.

The Quran says:

72:9	he will find a ball of fire waiting for him	يَجِدْ لَهُ شِهَابًا رَصَدًا
9:107	for lying in wait for those who fight against Allah and His Rasul (i.e. against Allah’s system)	إِرْصَادَ الَّذِينَ حَارَبُوا اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ

“الْمِرْصَادُ” (*al-mirsad*), “الْمِرْصَادُ” (*al-mirsad*): to ambush, or the place where the enemy is ambushed from. (89:14, 9:5){T}.

For God to be in “مِرْصَادٌ” (*mirsad*) or to ambush, means that His law of Nature keeps full track of everybody and when the need arises, that is, when the time for result comes, then it clutches people in its grip (89:14). Nobody can escape this law. Every human deed travels the path fixed by the law of Nature created by God to reach its destination, and which is called its end or result. Therefore, no deed can be without a result, good or bad.

R-Sd-Sd ر ص ص

“رَصَّه” (*rassahu*), “يَرُصُّهُ” (*yarussuh*), “رَصًّا” (*rassa*): he integrated the elements of a thing strongly as if they were iron clad.
“الرَّصَّاصُ” (*ar-rasaas*) means ‘lead’ (the metal).

The Quran says that *momins* fight in the way of their Sustainer:

61:4	as if they were parts of a lead wall (i.e. an unshakeable wall)	كَأَنَّهُمْ بُنْيَانٌ مَرْصُورٌ
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This can only happen when the hearts are integrated and when there is complete unity of thoughts and actions. The union of hearts comes from the code of life being homogenous. Consider the fate of the Muslim nations which are divided into different sects today, against this advice! But still we believe that we are the torch bearers of the system of Quran!

R-Zd-Ain ر ض ع

“رَضِعَ” (*razia*), “يَرُضِعُ” (*yarza*), “رَضَعٌ” (*raza’a*), “يَرُضِعُ” (*yarzih*), “رَضْعًا” (*razun*), “رَضَاعًا” (*raza-un*), “رَضَاعَةً” (*raza’a*): for an infant to suckle from its mother’s breast {T, R}.

4:23	your sisters who have suckled the breasts of the same woman (and which are forbidden for you to wed)	أَخَوَاتُكُم مِّنَ الرِّضَاعَةِ
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“أَرَضَعَ” (*arza’a*): to suckle a child.
“الْإِسْتِرْضَاعُ” (*al-istirza-u*): wanted to suckle {T}

4:23	those mothers (those women) who have breast-fed you (they are also forbidden for you to wed)	وَأُمَّهَاتُكُمُ اللَّاتِي أَرْضَعْنَكُمْ
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“مَرَضِعٌ” (*maradiah*): the place where you suckle, i.e. breasts {Kishaf}. Singular is “مَرَضِعٌ” (*marza’a*).

Surah *Al-Qasas* says:

28:12	we stopped Moosa from suckling	وَحَرَمْنَا عَلَيْهِ الْمَرَاضِعَ
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Here “مَرَاضِعٌ” (*marazi’h*) could also be plural for “مَرَضِعٌ” (*marza’a*), as well as of “مَرُضِعَةٌ” (*murziah*). In the first instance it would mean breasts. In the second those women who let a child suckle, that is, those who breast-fed the children.

“مَرُضِعَةٌ” (*murziah*): a woman who breast-feeds (22:2). The plural here too is “مَرَاضِعٌ” (*marazih*).
“إِسْتَرَضَعَ” (*istarzah*): wanted the (woman servant) to breast-feed the child (2:233).

“رَضِيَ” (*razia*), “يَرْضَى” (*yarzi*), “رِضْوَانًا” (*rizwana*), “رِضًا” (*rizan*): to agree with someone, to approve someone. But there is heartfelt agreement and willingness in it and no compulsion whatsoever.
 “تَرَاضِيَا” (*taraziayah*): both have agreed on something, with mutual agreement, both are agreed upon it.

2:232	when the two (husband and wife) mutually agreed	إِذَا تَرَاضَا بَيْنَهُمَا بِالْمَعْرُوفِ
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“رَضِيَهُ لِهَذَا الْأَمْرِ” (*raziahu lihaazil amr*): considered him capable of it. Considered him capable of serving him and selected him for the job.

“إِرْتَضَاهُ لِصُحْبَتِهِ وَخِدْمَتِهِ” (*irrazahu lisuhbatih wakhidmatih*): considered him to be worth of companionship and service and hence recruited him for this purpose.

“رَضِيتُ الشَّيْءَ وَبِهِ” (*razeetush shaiya wa behi*): I liked that thing and adopted it {T, L}.

2:120	The Christians and the Jews will never agree with you. They will never be in agreement.	لَنْ تَرْضَى عَنْكَ الْيَهُودُ وَلَا النَّصَارَى
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The Quran says that *momineen* will be “رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ وَرَضُوا عَنْهُ” (*razi Allahu unhum wa razu unhu*) in 9:100. It is generally translated as “Allah agreed with them, and they became content with Allah”. Since to agree and disagree are human emotions, this diverts the mind as if Allah too is subject to these feelings. He too is happy about something and displeased with some. Allah is free of all such emotions. Therefore the meaning of this verse is different. One thing should be clarified first here. When the human mind was in its infancy, it had the concept of god, goddesses or Allah as the king or ruler before him and in which there was nobody stronger than the king. His mind too sat Allah on a throne like the king. Then he thought that like the king, Allah too had those close to him who have some say in his rule. Also he has guards etc. and His subjects who have no right against him.

If a human being wanted to present some request before Him, he would also have to accompany it with presents and all. Also the request would have to be presented before God through one of His close ones. So that he could intervene on his/her behalf. These requests (or the king’s other orders) were not subject to any rule. They depended on the king’s whims. If he was happy then he could well grant a person an entire village. If he was angered then the man would face his wrath. This state of the king’s happiness or displeasure was not according to any rule. As such man should strive to maximum to keep God happy. Presents, gifts, sacrifice, all this was aimed at keeping the Deity happy and in agreement. So that He remained in agreement with his subjects.

The Quran (and before it the holy scriptures of the messengers through revelation) dispelled this superstitious concept of God and replaced it with the right concept. This was that God was not like a hedge monist ruler. He has fixed a rule for everything, and the entire affairs of the universe are conducted according to the laws formulated by Him. For human affairs too, He has formulated principles (which are now safe in the Quran and have come through the prophets). Every human deed results according to those laws. He, like the kings, does not reward anyone for nothing or on a whim, nor does he get angry on a frivolous thing and punish him.

Along with this, the Quran also said that God has a fixed purpose for the human life, and the laws He has given are ones according to which a human must live, and thus reach his ultimate destiny. This road for humans is favored by God. That is, if man takes this path then he lives according to God’s wishes, and if he does not then he goes against God’s wishes. “God’s agreement” or his displeasure as mentioned in the Quran signifies these meanings.

As for example, surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:3	I have chosen Islam (security) as your way of living	وَرَضِيتُ لَكُمُ الْإِسْلَامَ دِينًا
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If man lives according to this code of conduct, then he traverses a way that is favored by God. This has been said as “رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ” (*raziallahu unhu*). On the other side, a *momin's* state is such that he loves the path of God, and dislikes other ways against it.

49:8	But God has made trust beloved in your hearts and one to believe, and made denial, and hypocrisy, and sins as disliked. Such people are on the right path, this is a benevolence from Allah. And Allah is aleem and hakeem (He knows and is tactful)	وَلَكِنَّ اللَّهَ حَبَّبَ إِلَيْكُمُ الْإِيمَانَ وَزَيَّنَهُ فِي قُلُوبِكُمْ وَكَرَّهَ إِلَيْكُمُ الْكُفْرَ وَالْفُسُوقَ وَالْعِصْيَانَ أُولَٰئِكَ هُمُ الرَّاشِدُونَ فَضْلًا مِنَ اللَّهِ وَنِعْمَةً - وَاللَّهُ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ
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For trust to become so enamored in the hearts is “رَضُوا عَنْهُ” (*razu unhu*).

This will make one understand the meaning of “رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ وَرَضُوا عَنْهُ” (*razi Allahu unhum wa razu unhu*) as in 9:100, for Allah to be in agreement means to traverse the path set out by Allah. And to agree with humans means for Allah's recommended path to become the beloved path in their hearts.

The Quran explains this matter at another place as well. As in surah *At-Taubah* it is said about the hypocrites:

9:8	They agree with you by word of mouth but their hearts deny it	يُرْضُونَكَ بِأَفْوَاهِهِمْ وَتَأَلَّى قُلُوبُهُمْ
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Here “رَضَاءُ” (*irzaa*) has come opposite “أَبَى” (*aabaa*) which means to refute strongly. As such “رَضَى” (*raziun*) would mean to agree from the heart. This meaning is also explicit in surah *Al-Baqarah*, when these hypocrites are told “إِتَّقِ اللَّهَ” (*ittaqillah*) in 2:206, or protect the laws of Allah, they do not do so. After that the *momineen* are mentioned. That they live a life of “إِبْتِغَاءَ مَرْضَاتِ اللَّهِ” (*ibtigha'a maraatillah*) in 2:208, which means according to Allah's laws. Further ahead it is said:

2:208	Enter into (the domain of) God's obedience entirely	أَدْخُلُوا فِي السَّلَامِ كَافَّةً
8:2-6	do not follow ungodly orders	لَا تَتَّبِعُوا خُطُوَاتِ الشَّيْطَانِ

When all these pieces are kept in mind, it becomes clear what “مَرْضَاتِ اللَّهِ” (*marzaatillah*) means. That is, the obedience of Allah's laws with full willingness.

This is also the meaning of “رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ وَرَضُوا عَنْهُ” (*raziullahu unhum warizwanuhu*). That is, due to following Allah's laws, these people live peacefully and in harmony. Their entire life is spent according to these laws, and the happy results of following Allah's laws accompany them. The good results accompany them and due to this, their love for the love of Allah's laws increases.

This is called “إِتَّبَعَ رِضْوَانَ اللَّهِ” (*ittaba'a rizwanillah*) in 3:161 ز Against which has been stated “بِئَاءَ يَسْخَطُ مِنَ اللَّهِ” (*ba'a bisakhatin minallah*). See heading (S-Kh-Th).

Surah *Mohammed* makes it clear that “رِضْوَانَهُ” (*rizwanahu*) means the same as “مَا نَزَّلَ اللَّهُ” (*ma nazzalallahu*) (47:28). That is, the Quran.

Earlier it has been stated “كَرِهُوا مَا نَزَّلَ اللَّهُ” (*karihu ma anzalallah*) in (47:26) and after it has been said “كَرِهُوا رِضْوَانَهُ” (*karihu rizwaanahu*) in 47:28. This means that “رِضْوَانَهُ” (*rizwaanahu*) is to follow the Quran and “سَخَطُ” (*sakhatun*) is following ungodly laws. Therefore *momineen* are wont to fully obey and follow the Quran “مَا نَزَّلَ اللَّهُ” (*ma anzalallah*). They tune their entire life to the Quranic laws. And the result as per the laws of Nature is the delights and pleasantness of life which accompany them. This sort of life is “عِيشَةٍ رَاضِيَةٍ” (*eeshatir raazyiah*) (101:7).

Surah *Maryam* says that *Zikaria* prayed to God for a son and said:

19:6	And make him pleasing of my Sustainer	وَاجْعَلْهُ رَبِّ رَضِيًّا
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Here “رَضِيًّا” (*raziyyah*) means either beloved or favored or that he (the son) may be a person who lives his life according to Your laws.

Taj-u-Uroos says that “رَضِيّ” (*razzi*) means obedient.

Surah **At-Taubah** says that the *momineen* have been promised “جَنَّاتٍ” (*jannaat*) by Allah, and “مَسَاكِينٌ طَيِّبَةٌ” (*massakinit tayyibah – decent residences*). Later, it is said:

9:79	Allah’s ‘rizwaan’ is greater than all this. And this is a great achievement.	وَرِضْوَانٌ مِّنَ اللَّهِ أَكْبَرُ ذَٰلِكَ هُوَ الْفَوْزُ الْعَظِيمُ
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This verse points to a great truth. The question is what happens due to trust and ‘righteous deeds? The human being is a compound of this physical life and his ego or personality. Life’s success is that his physical being is good as well as the development of his ego. The development of a human being means that whatever latent capabilities he has, develops and is manifested. Allah’s personality or persona is a complete persona, in which all His qualities are in full bloom. These very same qualities are present in humans too, but only to the extent a human being can have them. That is, on a much smaller scale. The development of human personality means that those traits grow. Now it is obvious that the more developed a human personality will be the more qualities of Allah he will reflect and to a greater degree.

With trust and good deeds the human personality is developed while he also gets the benefits of a good life. The Quran says that life’s delights are very valuable too, and to get them is a big achievement. But the real success is that the human personality reflects the traits of God. “ذَٰلِكَ هُوَ الْفَوْزُ الْعَظِيمُ” (*zalika huwal fauzil azeem*).

The result of good deeds is that on one’s life becomes successful and delightful, and secondly his internal self also experiences a great change. This revolution (i.e. for human personality to be developed) is a very great success. This has been said in another way:

50:35	There will be everything in jannat which you may desire, and We have even more than that	لَيْسَ مَا يَشَاءُونَ فِيهَا وَلَدَيْنَا مَزِيدٌ
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This means that man’s wishes can only be according to his mental level but in the life of *jannat*, this level will be raised and then they will wish for, and get that which is much beyond the level at present. That is, his personality will be developed in such a way that the present level of his comprehension is unable to grasp it.

But we should not overlook the fact that such development of a human personality can take place only in a Quranic society, not in secluded worship houses. Thus we see that “رِضْوَانٌ مِنَ اللَّهِ” (*rizwaan minal lah*) or “مَرْضَاتُ اللَّهِ” (*marazaatillah*) is the name of living according to the Quran and the good results that follow from it.

Surah **Al-Ambia** says:

21:28	And they do not put in words for anyone, except for those who has His good pleasure	وَلَا يَسْمَعُونَ إِلَّا لِمَنْ ارْتَضَىٰ
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See heading (Sh-F-Ain).

R-Te-B ر ط ب

“الرَّطْبُ” (*ar-ratb*), is the opposite of “يَابِسٌ” (*yaabis - dry*): i.e. moist, or fresh and dewy. Hence it means soft, fresh branch, green grass, green land etc.
 “الرُّطَبُ” (*ar-rutab*): a kind of date {T}.

The Quran says:

19:25	selected dates	رُطَبًا جَنِيًّا
6:59	Freshness of everything is found in the code of life for	وَلَا رُطْبٌ وَلَا يَابِسٌ إِلَّا فِي كِتَابٍ مُّبِينٍ

the universe.	
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For “رَطْبٌ وَ يَابِسٌ” (*ratbi wa yabisun*), see heading (Y-B-S).

In verse 19:25, it is said that *Isa* (Jesus) was born in a season when trees were laden with ripe dates. This means that according to the Quran, *Isa* was not born in December, as generally believed. In that month there is a harsh winter in Palestine and it is not the season for fresh dates. Nowadays even the Christian historians are agreeing with the view that Jesus was not born on 25th December (Christmas). The Christians had borrowed this idea from the Iranians who thought that 25th December is Jesus’ birthday. And 25th March as the Day of the resurrection. They also believed that *Mithra* (Zoroastrian deity) would return during the last days of the world. (See page 51 of my book *Meraaj Insaaniyat*).

R-Ain-B ر ع ب

“رَعَبَ الْخَوْضَ” (*ra’abal hauz*): filled the (small) pool.

“رَعَبَ السَّيْلِ الْوَادِي” (*a’abas sailul wadi*): the flood filled the valley; to cut something.

“رَعَبَ السَّانَمِ” (*ra’abas sanaam*): he cut the hump (of the camel).

“الَّتَرْ عَيْتَهُ” (*attareeba*): the hump that was cut {T}.

Raghib says that due to being filled with fear, “الرُّعْبُ” (*ar-roab*) means to become speechless {R}. This word is also used for just fear.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:18	lest you become fearful due to it	وَلَمَّا لَأْتَتْ مِنْهُمْ رُعباً
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The *momineen* should be so powerful that their opponents, upon seeing them in battle, shake with fear. But this is only possible when they bow before Allah’s laws and of none else. This is what we know as “توحيد” (*tauheed*), while *shirk* (to follow other rules as well) definitely results in fear.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:150	We will put fear into the hearts of these deniers, because they include others with Allah (in following laws)	سَنُلْقِي فِي قُلُوبِ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا الرُّعْبَ بِمَا أَشْرَكُوا بِإِلَهِ اللَّهِ
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R-Ain-D ر ع د

“رَعْدٌ” (*raad*): thunder. It also means to shake or tremble. It figuratively also means scolding or dressing down.

“الرَّعَادُ” (*ar-raad*): a man who talks tall, talks too much {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means basically movement and unease.

In the Quran this word has been used as meaning thunder (13:13, 2:19)

13:13	Raad is busy in carrying out its ordained task	وَيُسَبِّحُ الرَّعْدُ بِحَمْدِهِ
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This means that it is an epitome of Allah’s praise with its positive result See headings (S-B-H) and (H-M-D). Every force of the universe is engaged in its ordained task, and the collective result of their efforts is a constructive addition to the universe. When viewed separately, some of these forces evoke fear (like

lightning and thunder) but collectively their result is constructive. And this is the manifestation of Allah's praise.

R-Ain-N ر ع ن

“الرَّعُونَةُ” (*ar-rao'nah*): means foolishness. It is also said that “رُعُونَةٌ” (*rao'na*) means sparseness of thought and “حُمَقٌ” (*humaq*) means refutation of intellect or thought {M}.

“الْأَرُعُنُّ” (*al-arun*): a man who talks nonsense, fool, lazy and lackadaisical.

“رَعَنَ الرَّجُلُ” (*ra-unir rajul*): that fool talked nonsense and became loose.

“رُعِنَ” (*ro'in*): he fainted {T}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to be projected ahead and to be high or elevated. Second meaning is of nonsense, worries and unease.

“رَاعِنًا” (*ra'ina*): the Jews used to address the Messenger (*pbuh*) by this word (4:46). It was meant to tie him up with “رَعُونَتَ” (*ra-oonat*) but they used to say it as “رَاعِنًا” (*ra'ina*) which means to condescend, to bear with us {R}, or as they say in English, “I beg your pardon”.

For detailed meaning of “رَاعِنًا” (*ra'ina*), see heading (R-Ain-Y).

R-Ain-Y ر ع ي

“الرَّعْيُ” (*ar-riou*): grass.

“الرَّعْيُ” (*ar-raayou*), “الرَّمْعُ” (*al-mar'aa*): to graze grass.

“الرَّمْعُ” (*al-mar'aa'a*): grazing land, also the grass which is grazed.

“رَعَى” (*ra-aya*), “يَرْعَى” (*yar'aa*), “رَعِيًا” (*rayuia*): the animals grazed, or left the animals to graze.

“الرَّاعِي” (*ar-raee*): shepherd, one of the plurals is “رِعَاءٌ” (*riaa-un*). See 28:32 {T}.

Raghib says “رَعَى” (*ray'un*) actually is to look after an animal and protect it in every way, whether it is to preserve its life by feeding it, or by protecting it from enemies etc. {R}. But later this word came into use for protecting and looking after everything.

“رَعَى أَمْرَهُ” (*as-raee amrahu*): looked after his affair and protected it.

“رَعَى النُّجُومَ وَرَاعَاهَا” (*raeen nujum wara'aha*): he kept track of the stars and their speed and looked after them {T}.

“مُرَاعَاةً” (*mura'atun*) means to look after something specifically, to protect someone.

“رَاعَى أَمْرَهُ” (*raaya amruhu*): he looked after his affair very well and kept an eye on his wealth.

“الرَّعِيَّةُ” (*ar-raeeyah*): the animals which are looked after or which are left to graze. It also means those people who have some administrator for their affairs and who are watched over by someone {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to protect and oversee.

Surah **Taha** says:

20:54	feed your cattle	وَارْعُوا أَنْعَامَكُمْ
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“الرَّمْعُ” (*al-mar'aa*): grass or fodder (87:4).

Surah **Al-Hadees** says about Monasticism:

57:27	they could not protect it the way it should have been	فَمَا رَعَوْهَا حَقَّ رِعَائِهَا
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	protected	
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Surah *Al-mominoon* says:

23:8	those who protect their goods and keep their promises sacred	وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ لِأَمْتِهِمْ وَعَهْدِهِمْ رَاعُونَ
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In surah *Al-Baqrah*, the group of *momineen* have been asked not to say “رَاعِنَا” (*raa ina*) like the Jews (2:102). The Jews used to twist the words while addressing the Messenger (*pbuh*) in order to change the meanings of the spoken words. The word “رَاعِنَا” (*ra'ina*) was among such twisted words. This was the peak of their lowliness that they had even given up normal courtesy and came down to street language.

They used to say the word in such a way, as to make it a derivative of “رُعُونْتَ” (*ra'onat*). See heading (R-Ain-Y). But *Al-Minar* says that “رَاعِنَا” (*raa ina*) is derived from “مُرَاعَاةً” (*mura ah*). In this way “رَاعِنَا” (*ra'ina*) would mean that you concede to us and then we will concede to you. To use such words for the Messenger (*pbuh*) is open disrespect and unbecoming. {*Al-Minar* vol.1 page 410}. That is, the prophet should be obeyed unconditionally which actually is obedience of Allah and their life's duty. They should say “أُنْظُرْنَا” (*unzarna*) to the Messenger (*pbuh*) prophet. It means, look after us lest we become wayward, and they should not only listen to all his orders but obey them as well. “وَأَسْمَعُوا” (*wasma'o*) (2:102).

But in my opinion, this verse tells even those who trust, to abstain from such acts and talk in which good and bad are mixed, or their difference is difficult to comprehend readily. If some saying or act has even a doubt that anything (word or deed) insulting the Messenger (*pbuh*), then that should be avoided and the purity of intent must not be cited for saying or doing them. Everything a Muslim says or does must be clear and unambiguous. There is no room for a poetic license sort of thing here.

R-Gh-B ر غ ب

Ibn Faris says it means basically to demand or wish, and vastness.

- “رَغَبَ” (*raghbah*): actually it means for something to become vast or wide.
- “رَغَبَ الشَّيْءُ” (*raghubash shaiyi*): the thing became vast.
- “حَوْضٌ رَغِيبٌ” (*raghiba hauzun*): a vast pool.
- “الرَّغْبُ” (*ar-raghbaha*), “الرَّغْبُ” (*ar-raghbu*): to wish very much, the vastness of intent {R}.
- “وَادٍ رَغِيبٌ” (*raghib waadin*): a broad valley which can hold a lot of water.
- “تَرَاغَبَ الْمَكَانُ” (*taraghabal makaan*): the place widened, became vast.
- “أَرْغَبَ اللَّهُ قَدْرَكَ” (*arghabal lahu qadraka*): May God increase your respect or rank.
- “الرَّغَابُ” (*ar-righaab*): animals which give a lot of milk and are very beneficial.
- “رَغِيبٌ” (*ragheeb*): every vast and broad thing {T}

Raghib says “رَغِبَ فِيهِ يَا رَغِبَ إِلَيْهِ” (*raghiba fih ya raghiba ilaih*): to wish for something and to long for it (with the broadness of intent). “إِنَّا إِلَى اللَّهِ رَاغِبُونَ” (*inna ilal lahi raaghiboon*) as in 9:59 also means the same. Also in 68:32 and “رَغِبَ عَنْهُ” (*raghiba unhu*) means to turn away one's liking from it {R}.

2:130	Who can turn away from the leadership of Ibrahim?	وَمَنْ يَرْغَبْ عَنْ مِلَّةِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ
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Also in 19:46 “رَغِبَ” (*raghib*) has been followed by “عَنْ” (*un*). At these places, this word means to take away liking from.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:127	you do not want to give widows and orphan girls what they should be given according to God's laws, and yet you want to wed them	لَا تُؤْتُونَهُنَّ مَا كُتِبَ لَهُنَّ وَتَرْغَبُونَ أَلْ تَنْكَحُوهُنَّ
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Taj-ul-Uroos explains further that “رَغِبَ فِيهِ” (*raghiba feeh*) means liked him, intended it.

R-Gh-D

ر غ د

“رَغَدٌ رَغْدٌ” (*eeshatun raghadun*) “رَغَدٌ” (*raghadah*): good, abundant and delightful earning.

“رَغَدٌ عَيْشُهُمْ” (*raghida aishehum*): their lives became delightful and their earning (income) abundant or vast.

“أَرْغَدُوا مَوَاشِيَهُمْ” (*arghdiu mawashiahum*): they left their cattle to graze freely.

“أَرْغَدُوا” (*arghadu*): they reached a fertile land {T, M}.

“الرَّغْدُ” (*ar-raghadu*): abundant wealth, water, grass, earning etc. which causes no constriction and which is no cause for any worry {T}.

In surah *Al-Baqarah*, the characteristics of *janna* (heavenly society), have been detailed as that in which earnings will be “رَغَدًا حَيْثُ شِئْتُمْ” (*raghadan haisu shai'tuma*) (2:35). That is, life's necessities can be easily fulfilled from anywhere.

Surah *Taha* says in this context that in such a society the edibles, clothing and the basic necessities of life will be available without any effort (20:118), and man shall not be deprived of these.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:112	The basic characteristic of such a heavenly society on earth is that every necessity of life is easily available to everybody, everywhere and in abundance	يَأْتِيهَا رِزْقُهَا رَغَدًا مِنْ كُلِّ مَكَانٍ
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In such a society, people cannot inveigle the fountainheads of sustenance for themselves only. All means for development of the human being and his capabilities are freely available to all and it is the responsibility of that system that it ensures that nobody is deprived and everything is available to him in abundance.

“رَغَدًا حَيْثُ شِئْتُمْ” (*raghadan haisu shai'tuma*): available feely from wherever he wants.

“الرَّغْمُ” (*ar-ragham*), “الرُّغْمُ” (*ar-rugham*), “الرَّغْمُ” (*ar-righm*): dislike, abhorrence.

“الرَّغْمُ” (*ar-ragham*) or “الرَّغَامُ” (*ar-raghaam*) actually means ‘dust’.

“أَرُغِمَهُ الذُّلُّ” (*arghanaz-zullu*): his face was rubbed in the dirt. This also means to make one obey forcibly.

“الْمَرْغَمُ” (*al-margham*) means ‘nose’ {T}.

“الْمُرَاغَمُ” (*al-muragham*): a place where one may go after running away, or after being angry with someone. Later it also came to mean fort, path, and spaciousness and abundance {T}.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings. One is of dirt, while the other is of a path or a place to run away to.

The Quran says that anyone who migrates in order to establish Allah’s system:

4:100	will find lots of sanctuaries in the world where he will find abundance	يَجِدُ فِي الْأَرْضِ مُرَاغِمًا
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And if the opponents have closed one door for him, then dozens of doors will open up.

“رُفَاتٌ” (*rufaat*): chaff or that which falls off from a dry thing. Hence it means old pieces and bits.

“ارْفَتَّ الْحَبْلُ” (*irfattal hubl*): the rope broke into pieces.

“رَفَاتَهُ” (*rafatah*), “يَرْفُتُهُ” (*yarfutuh*): to break something, to pound or turn into small pieces. Like earth or old bones {T, R}.

Surah **Bani Israel** says:

17:49	will we be raised even after our bones turn to dust?	إِذْ أَكُنَّا عِظًا مَّأْوًى رُفَاتًا
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Like today’s materialists, they too thought that their life was confined only to their physical being. If the elements of life disintegrate, then life can’t go on. Their thoughts have been dispelled by saying that God, who created them the first time, is capable of maintaining life without these physical elements as well (17:51). This is what life after death is.

“الرَّفَثُ” (*ar-rafas*) is a composite word and means everything to do with sexual intercourse, from the initial conversation to the climax {T}.

Muheet says it means a man who performs the intercourse {T, R}. It also means cases of sexual intercourse.

Raghib says it means sexual intercourse or talk about it, the mentioning of which is deemed improper.

Ibn Faris says it actually means sexual intercourse but is used for anything which a man feels shame to express.

“الرَّفَثُ” (*rafas*) means abuse or inappropriate talk as well.

In the context of **Hajj**, it is said “فَلَارَفَتْ” (*fala rafas*) in 2:197. It means that during **Hajj** no dirty thought should enter the mind. No such act should be committed nor should any conversation which has a sexual overtone, be made.

About fasting, the Quran says:

2:187	you can go to your wives for sexual intercourse in the nights of the month of fasting	أُجِلَّ لَكُمْ لَيْلَةَ الصِّيَامِ الرَّفَثُ إِلَى نِسَائِكُمْ
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Here the Quran by using “إِلَى نِسَائِكُمْ” (*ila nisaikum*) (your women), has made it clear that it means sexual intercourse.

R-F-D

ر ف د

“الرَّفْدُ” (*ar-rifd*): Gift, compensation. It also means something with which one gives support, help, share or luck.

“رَفَدَهُ” (*rafadah*), “يُرْفِدُهُ” (*yurfiduhu*), “رَفَدَا” (*rafda*): he helped him, or gave him aid.

“الْإِرْفَادُ” (*al-irfaad*): to help, to gift, to endow. It is actually the cloth or other soft material under the camel’s seat so that it does not hurt the animal’s back.

“رِفَادَةٌ” (*rifadah*): piece of cloth to wipe the wound. It also means the contribution that was gathered in the days of ignorance by the **Quresh** tribe for the needy pilgrims forage.

“الْإِرْتِفَادُ” (*al-irtifaad*): to labor, to strive, to earn {**T, R**}.

Surah **Hood** says:

11:99	how bad a gift or compensation it is	بِئْسَ الرِّفْدُ الْمَرْفُودُ
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That is, how bad is the help which has been given them or with which they have been supported.

R-F-Ain

ر ف ع

“رَفَعَ” (*raf’a*), “يُرْفَعُ” (*yarf’a*): to elevate.

Raghib has said sometimes “رَفَعَ” (*rafa*) means to lift a material object, sometimes to build up a wall at the time of construction and take it to a height, sometimes to elevate fame or mention or sometimes to elevate the grade {**T, R**}.

Ibn Faris says it means basically means to elevate and pick. It also means to bring a thing closer, or to spread or make manifest.

“رَفَعَ” (*raf’a*) is used in various meanings. Its basic meaning contains the sense of intensity or exaggeration. That is to do whatever, quickly and intensely.

“رَفَعَ الْبَعِيرُ فِي سَيْرِهِ” (*as-rafaal baeeru fi sairih*): the camel increased his speed.

“رَفَعَ الْقَوْمُ” (*raf’ al qaum*): the people went up to the heights.

“بَرَقَ رَافِعٌ” (*barqun raaf’ih*): the lightning which shines high above.

“الرُّفَاعَةُ” (*ar-rifa’ah*): the harshness of sound and intensity.

“رَفَعٌ” (*raf’u*), “رِفْعَةٌ” (*rif’ah*): to be gentlemanly and of high stature {**T**}.

The Quran says:

2:63	We raised the mount of Toor near your head	رَفَعْنَا فَوْقَكُمْ الطُّورَ
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That is, you were at the bottom and the mount was above you. In connotation of being the height of a building, it says in the context of the construction of the **Kaba**:

2:127	when Ibrahim was raising the foundations of this house	إِذْ يَرْفَعُ إِبْرَاهِيمُ الْقَوَاعِدَ
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“رَفَعَ صَوْتًا” (*rafa’a sautan*): raised voice.

“رَفَعَ صَوْتَهُ فَوْقَ صَوْتِهِ” (*rafa’a sautahu fauqa sautehi*): literally, it means to raise one’s voice above another’s, but figuratively it means to impose one’s opinion over another’s (49:2).

About the elevation of grade, it is said about **Idrees**:

19:57	We granted him elevated grade	وَرَفَعْنَاهُ مَكَانًا عَلِيًّا
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God has himself called himself “رَفِيعُ الدَّرَجَاتِ” (*rafiud darajaat*) in 40:15, that is, he did not reach His elevated position gradually, but He is there from the beginning. That is, He is above the process of evolution and progress. It also means supremacy and authority.

“رَفِيعُ الدَّرَجَاتِ” (*rafiud darjaat*): of high grade, that is, of high ranks. It could also mean one who elevates stages or grades or ranks.

In surah **Al-Waaqiah** where “رَافِعَةٌ” (*raafiah*) has come opposite “خَافِضَةٌ” (*khafizah*), there too, it means this. That is, the one who gets elevated to great heights.

About **Isa** it is said “بَلَّ رَفَعَهُ اللَّهُ إِلَيْهِ” (*bal rafahul lahu ilaih*) in 4:158, there too the meaning is that Allah elevated him and brought him close to Himself. If “رَفَعَ” (*rafa*) is taken to mean that he was lifted physically, then one would have to accept that God is at a certain place. Because whenever it is said that something has gone towards something, the thing towards which it has gone, has to be at a fixed place. It is against the Quran to believe that God is confined to any one place.

That is why “بَلَّ رَفَعَهُ اللَّهُ إِلَيْهِ” (*bal rafahul laahu ilaih*) would mean that Allah elevated him and brought him closer to Him. Details will be found in my book **Sholayi Mastoor** in the tale about **Isa**.

About the Messenger (*pbuh*) it is said:

94:4	we elevated your greatness	وَرَفَعْنَا لَكَ ذِكْرَكَ
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For “رَفَعَ” (*rafa’a*) and “صَعِدَ” (*sa’ida*) as in 35:10, see heading (Sd-Ain-D).

R-F-F ر ف ف

“رَفَّ” (*ruff*) has a lot of meanings but the Quran only uses “رَفْرَفٌ” (*rafrarafun*) in 55:76.

“رَفَّ الطَّائِرُ” (*raffat-tairu*) and “رَفْرَفٌ” (*rafrarf*): the bird opened up its wings in the air.

“الرَّفْرَفُ” (*ar-rufuf*): scattered leaves.

“الرَّفْرَفُ” (*ar-rafrufu*): mat, beddings, pillows, also green colored mattresses which are laid over floor covering to sleep. Some say it means the hem etc. of a tent’s curtain, but generally it means floor covering or bedding {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it means gardens, beddings, and green clothing.

R-F-Q ر ف ق

“الرِّمْفَقُ” (*al-mirfaq*): elbow. Plural is “مَرَفِقٌ” (*marafiq*). It also means softness and facility.

“رَفَقَ النَّاقَةُ” (*rafagan naaqa*): the camel’s elbow was fastened so that it does not run away.
 “رَفَقَ” (*rifaqa*): the rope with which one’s arm is tied (to its hind legs). This led to “الرَّفَقَةُ” (*al-rifqah*) meaning companion in the group (because while walking, their elbows touch each other). When the group disperses then the word “رَفَقَةُ” (*rifqah*) is not used for them, but every companion can be called “رَفِيقٌ” (*rafiq*).
 “الرَّفَاقَةُ” (*ar-rufaaqah*): group or party.
 “ارْتَفَقَ” (*irtafaqa*): he leaned on the elbow.
 “الْمُرْتَفَقُ” (*al-murtafaqa*): anything which is leaned on, such as pillow or any other support {M}. Since this sort of leaning gives comfort, “ارْتَفَقَ بِهِ” (*irtafaqa behi*) means benefited from it.
 “رَفَقَ بِهِ” (*rafaqa behi*) or “رَفَقَ عَلَيْهِ” (*rafaqa ilaih*): dealt with him softly {T}.

Ibn Faris says that this root basically means to be close to one another and agree mutually without any violence or coercion.

The Quran says:

4:69	They are good companions	حَسَنَ أَوْلِيكَ رَفِيقًا
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Hence it means companions whose companionship during travel completes one’s shortcomings so that the balance in his personality and the society is maintained. For ‘elbow’ this word has been used in 5:6.

Surah **Al-Kahaf** says:

18:16	He will facilitate or provide ease in the purpose before you	يُهَيِّئْ لَكُمْ مِنْ أَمْرِكُمْ مَرْفَاقًا
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The same surah calls *janna* (heavenly society) as “حَسُنَتْ مُرْتَفَقًا” (*hasunat murtafaqa*) in 18:31 and *jahannum* (hellish society) as “سَاءَتْ مُرْتَفَقًا” (*sa’at murtafaqa*) in 18:29, that is, a place to lean on, or on whose support one can rise. Life in *jahannum* is such that man cannot traverse the evolutionary stages with its support. Life in *janna*, however, is such that it is the best support for rising high and going towards the heights. It is a support which never lets the balance be unbalanced, that is, “حَسُنَتْ مُرْتَفَقًا” (*hasunat murtafaqa*). Supports are present in a *jahannami* or hellish society too, but they are quite uneven. That is why they cannot support a man for standing on his own two feet. His personality’s development can’t be helped by them. Only *jannati* society’s supports can help a man do so. And while keeping their balance, they progress ahead.

R-Q-B

رق ب

“الرَّقَبَةُ” (*ar-raqabah*): neck.

“رَقَبَهُ” (*raqabahu*): tied a rope around his neck, since when a man’s necked is roped, he becomes obedient and thus this word generally began to mean a slave. Plural is “الرَّقَبَةُ” (*ar-raqab*).

“الرِّقَابُ” (*ar-riqaab*) means ‘slave’ as used in 2:177. Singular is “رَقَبَهُ” (*raqabah*) as used in 4:92 {T}.

“رَقَبَ” (*raqab*), “يَرْقُبُ” (*yarqub*): to wait for, and to protect and look after.

“وَلَمْ تَرْقُبْ قَوْلِي” (*walam tarqub qauli*), as in 20:94. Here it can mean wait for, as well as to look after, and to consider. “يَتَرَقَّبُ” (*yatarraqab*) in 28:18 also has this meaning but with reference to the context, it may mean to wait anxiously, or more appropriate, be looking for something.

Taj-ul-Uroos says it means to expect something and to wait for it.

Raghib says it means to avoid something while waiting for something. That is, they used to raise their head to see whether someone was coming or not.

“الرَّقِيبُ” (*ar-raqueeb*) means the protector, or one who looks after something, or one who waits for something, or one who looks after (1:4, 33:52)

Ibn Faris says it means basically to oversee something. The neck is also called “الرَّقَبَةُ” (*ar-raqabah*) because it remains erect and at attention when looking for something.

It may also mean to consider someone’s feelings and to uphold someone’s words. This word has been used in 9:8 and in 20:94.

“ارْتَقَبَ الشَّيْءُ” (*artaqabash shaiyi*): to wait for something.

“ارْتَقَبَ الْمَكَانَ” (*irtaqabal makaan*): to climb to some place, or to be raised.

“مَرْقَبَةٌ” (*marqabah*): a place to climb.

“الرَّقَبَةُ” (*ariqbah*): protection and to fear, apprehend. It is used in both these meanings {*T*}.

Surah *Ad-Dukhaan* says “فَارْتَقِبَايَا” (*fartaqabaaya*) in 44:59, 44:10. Here it means to wait for.

Surah *Yunus* says:

10:102	Tell them to wait, and you as well wait with them.	قُلْ فَإِنْتُمْ تُنْتَظِرُونَ إِنِّي مَعَكُمْ مِنَ الْمُنْتَظِرِينَ
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R-Q-D

ر ق د

“الرَّقْدُ” (*ar-raqd*), “الرُّقَادُ” (*ar-ruqaad*), “الرُّقُودُ” (*ar-ruqud*): to sleep. In the Quran, this word has been used opposite “يَقَظُ” (*yaqaz*), or awakening.

18:18	you think they are awake whereas they are sleeping	وَنَحْسَبُهُمْ آيَظَاتًا وَهُمْ رُقُودٌ
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“مَرْقَدٌ” (*marqad*): bedroom, sleeping place.

Surah *Yasin* says:

36:52	who awakened us from our sleeping places (bedrooms)	مَنْ بَعَثْنَا مِنْ مَرْقَدِنَا
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Raghib says “الرُّقَادُ” (*aruqaad*) means a good nap {*R*}.

This clarifies the context of 18:18 in surah *Al-Kahaf* that they did not take a long sleep, they used to nap but that too with the caution that outsiders think that they were awake. This means that they were not oblivious of their safety at any time.

R-Q-Q

ر ق ق

“الرَّقِيقُ” (*ar-raq*), “الرَّقِيقُ” (*ar-riq*): thin membrane or skin used for writing.

“الرَّقِيقُ” (*ar-raq*): white page, white page with some writing on it {*T*, *R*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means fineness and softness.

“الرَّقِيقُ” (*ar-raq*), “الرَّقِيقُ” (*ar-raqeeq*): thin or fine thing.

“الرَّقِيقَةُ” (*ar-riqqah*): softness of the heart.

“الرَّقِيقُ” (*ar-riq*): slavery {*T*, *R*}.

The Quran says:

52:2-3	written book on fine, thin membrane	وَكُتُبٍ مَّنْشُورٍ فِي رَقٍّ مَّنْشُورٍ
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“رَقَمَ” (*raqam*), “يَرْقُمُ” (*yarqam*), “رَقْمًا” (*raqma*): to write.

“رَقَمَ الْكِتَابَ” (*raqamal kitaab*): wrote the book with punctuation so that the book was crystal clear {T}.

The Quran says:

83:9	clearly written book	كِتَابٌ مَرْقُومٌ
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“رَقَمَ الثَّوبَ” (*raqamus saub*): to make lines on the cloth and make marks to determine the price.

“دَابَّةٌ مَرْقُومَةٌ” (*da-abbatun marqumah*): the animal which has branding marks on his legs or lines {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means writing and to make lines.

With reference to *Khalil*, he says “الرَّقْمُ” (*ar-raqm*) means to make clear the writing with the help of punctuation, and a book is called “كِتَابٌ مَرْقُومٌ” (*kitabum marqum*) when it is well punctuated.

The Quran says “أَصْحَابُ الْكَهْفِ وَالرَّقِيمِ” (*ashaabul kahfin warraqeem*) in 18:9. It is generally taken to mean that the affairs about the caved people was written on a metal plate and affixed outside the cave. Thus they were called “أَصْحَابُ الرَّقِيمِ” (*ashabur raqeeem*).

“مَرْقُومٌ” (*marqum*) means written, but recent research says that this is the same word which has been termed as “رَاقِيمٌ” (*raaqeem*) in the *Torah*. This was the name of a city which became famous as *Petra* and which the Arabs called *Batrah*. It was situated north of the *Sinai* and *Bay of Aqaba* on a plateau. When in the second century A.D, the Romans merged Syria and Palestine, this city became famous as a Roman colony. After the First World War, big caves were discovered there with ruins of buildings in and outside caves. It is believed that according to 18:9, the “أَصْحَابُ الْكَهْفِ وَالرَّقِيمِ” (*ashaabul Kahafi war raqeeem*) had taken shelter in one of these very caves where later a statue was built to commemorate them. Also see heading *ashaabul kahaf wir raqeeem*.

“الرَّقْوُ” (*ar-raqwu*): small, sand dune.

“الرَّقْوَةُ” (*ar-raqwah*): the upper part of the chest below the throat where one sees a man breathing, the collar bone. Plural is “تَرَاقٍ” (*taraq*) and “التَّرَاقِي” (*at-taraaqi*) {T, M}.

75:26	When the breath comes above the chest (when you are about to die). When the end is near.	إِذْ بَلَغَتِ التَّرَاقِي
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The real meaning here is to climb.

“رَقَا الطَّائِرُ” (*raq at tair*) means the bird rose in its flight. See heading (R-Q-Y).

“رَقِيَ” (*raqi*), “يَرْقِي” (*yarqa*), “رُقْيًا” (*raqya*), “رُقِيًّا” (*ruqiyya*): to climb, or to progress and prosper {T, M}.

The Quran says:

17:93	Or, climb up to the sky	أَوْ تَرْقَى فِي السَّمَاءِ
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“التَّرْقُوءُ” (*at-tarquwah*): collar bone where one can see the breath climbing.

Plural is “تَرَاقِي” (*taraqin*) and “التَّرَاقِي” (*at- taraaqi*).

The Quran says:

75:26	When it reaches the collar bone	إِذَا بَلَغَتِ التَّرَاقِي
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See also heading (R-Q-W).

“الرُّقِيَّةُ” (*ar-ruqiyah*), “رَقَاهُ رَقِيًّا” (*raqaho raqiya*) a sort of thing.

“وَرُقِيًّا” (*wariqah*), “وَرُقِيَّةً” (*varqiyah*): He cast a spell over him or dispelled a spell.

“رَاقٍ” (*raaq*): one who cast spell.

The Quran says:

75:26	And is there anyone who can save himself by casting a spell?	وَقِيلَ مَنْ رَاقٍ
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Note: Some scholars of the dictionary accept “ت” (t) in the word but I think that “ت” (t) is additional and the root of the word is (R-Q-W).

Ibn Faris has said that “رَقِيَ” (*raqi*) means to climb, or spells etc.

“الرَّمْرَقَاةُ” (*al-marqatu*) and “الرَّمْرَقَاةُ” (*al-mirqaat*): climbing ladder {T}.

“الرَّاقَاةُ” (*ar-raqa'u*): mountain climber {T}.

R-K-B

ر ك ب

“رَكِبَهُ” (*rakibahu*), “يَرْكُبُهُ” (*yarkubuh*), “رُكُوبًا” (*rukuba*): to climb something, to rise, to mount {T}, either on an animal or on boards a boat etc.

18:71	when the two got on board the boat	إِذَا رَكِبَا فِي السَّفِينَةِ
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“رَاكِبٌ” (*raakib*): passenger. The plural is “الرَّكَبُ” (*ar-rakb*) as in 8:42. “رُكْبَانٌ” (*rukbaan*) as in 2:239, is the opposite of “رِجَالًا” (*rijaala*), which means on foot.

“الرَّكَّابُ” (*ar-rikaab*): the camels which are ridden (59:6). The singular is “رَاحِلَةٌ” (*raahila*) which is from a different root.

“رُكُوبٌ” (*rukub*): an animal which is used for riding (36:72).

“رَكَّبَ” (*rakkaba*): to put one thing on top of another, or to fix {T}. To make something climb {M}, to arrange (82:8).

“مُتَرَاكِبًا” (*mutraakiba*): one on top of another (6:100).

About man it is said in the Quran, that he has traversed various stages and will keep on traversing evolutionary stages and rise through them.

That is why surah *Inshiqaaq* says:

84:19	You climb from one condition to another and rise (up) in stages	الْمُتَرَكِّبُ طَبَقًا عَنْ طَبَقٍ
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The present stage of the human life is not its ultimate. It has to go much further and be elevated. Therefore death does not end the system of life. Dust (earth's) particles have evolved biologically to evolve to the human form. But within this form the human personality is not the result of evolution.

Thereafter the next stage of evolution develops, i.e. instead of the evolution of the human form (body), the evolution of the human personality. This evolution begins in this life but continues in the life

hereafter. That is, physical death does not stop it from going ahead. This verse may mean that humanity itself is rising by stages. History is a record of these stages.

R-K-D

ر ک د

“الرُّكُودُ” (*ar-rukud*): to be motionless.

“الرَّايِدُ” (*ar-rakid*): immobile thing {T, R, M}.

“رَكَدَتِ السَّفِينَةُ” (*rakadatis safeenah*): the boat anchored {T, R, M}.

“الرَّوَاكِدُ” (*ar-rawakid*): the three stones (or bricks) used by the Arab gypsies as a make-shift stove, the stones are immobile {T}.

The Quran says about boats:

42:33	stay put on the sea	رَوَاكِدَ عَلَى ظَهْرِهِ
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Become unable to move. That is, if God orders the winds to stop, then the sailing boats will stop moving.

R-K-Z

ر ک ز

“الرَّيْزُ” (*ar-rikz*): soft sound, tread, or sound which is low. Or human voice heard from afar like the bay of the hounds {T}.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:98	Or do you even hear them making a whimper?	أَوَتَسْمَعُهُمْ رِيْزًا
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“رَكَزْتُ كَذَا” (*rakaztu kaza*): I buried him secretly.

“الرَّيْكَازُ” (*ar-rikaaz*): buried treasure, as well as minerals which have been buried by God {R}.

“رَتَكَزَ” (*irtakaz*) means he stayed put and became stolid, because anything that is buried stays in its place {T}.

“رَكَزَ الرُّمْحَ” (*rakazar rumh*): he dug the spear into the earth.

“الرَّمَكَزُ” (*al-markaz*): the place where the spear has been dug in {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to bury (dig) something into something so that it become immobile or static.

R-K-S

ر ک س

“الرَّكْسُ” (*ar-raks*): to bend something in such a way that the front end meets its rear end {M}.

“رِكَاسٌ” (*rikaas*): a rope, one end of which is tied to the camel’s nose ring and the other end to its leg, and it is kept so tight that the camel’s head remains bent and is in severe pain. All this is to train it.

“إِرْتَاكَسَ” (*irtaks*): his head bent, he turned {T}.

The Quran says about the hypocrites:

4:88	Due to their (bad) deeds Allah made them lower their heads	وَاللَّهُ أَزْكَسَهُمْ بِمَا كَسَبُوا
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It means that Allah's laws insulted and demeaned them, or put them into severe trouble, or turned them back to their state of denial. This meaning appears in 4:91 as well.

R-K-Zd

ر ك ض

“الرَّكُضُ” (*ar-rakz*): to spur a horse so that it runs fast. It also means for a bird to prepare its wings to fly. It also means to run fast.

The Quran says:

21:12	They fled away from it	إِذَا هُمْ مِنْهَا يَرْكُضُونَ
21:13	Do not flee.	لَا تَرْكُضُوا

“الْمِرْكَزُ” (*al-mirkaz*): the thing which is used to stoke the fire to make it burn brighter {T, R, M}.

In surah *Saad*, it has been said about *Ayub*:

38:42	move on	أَرْكُضْ بِرِجْلِكَ
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To make your steps go fast. It can also mean put your leg into the water and move it.

Ibn Faris says “ركض” (*rikz*) basically means to move forward or to make mobile.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says “لَا تَرْكُضُوا” (*la tarkuzu*) which points to a big truth. Its earlier verse says that the nations which have their social system follow other than God's laws, create chaos in society. It makes the distribution of wealth severely unbalanced and this leads to destruction. But they are drunk with power and wealth and do not realize that they are proceeding towards destruction. Until that destruction stares them in the eye, they try to run away from it. But at that time God's consequential law calls out to them and say “لَا تَرْكُضُوا” (*la tarkuzu*) which means “do not try to run away, you cannot escape anywhere”.

21:13	Go back to those places	لَا تَرْكُضُوا
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Go back to your palatial houses which you had adorned with the color of the blood of the poor. Go back so that you may be asked: where all this wealth came from and what right had you over these luxuries?

This is indeed a true picture of the result of capitalism which the Quran has drawn.

Verses before 21:13 say that those nations that build their economic systems on other bases than those given by Allah, contribute in spreading disorder which ultimately results in destruction. But they are so blinded by their wealth that they never realize their path towards destruction. Instead when destruction starts to knock at their doors, they try to run away from its wrath. That is the time when the consequential law of Allah calls them “don't try to run away, you can't escape your consequences”.

21:13	Return to your palaces which you have created from the earnings of the needy	وَارْجِعُوا إِلَىٰ مَا أُتْرِفْتُمْ فِيهِ وَمَسْكِنُكُمْ
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Now go back to your previous states so you may be asked where your wealth came from and if you had any right to keep it as your own.

The Quran has made the whole system of capitalism with its many disadvantages crystal clear.

“رَكَعَ” (*raka'a*): to bend face down or to fall down, whether the knees touch the ground or not, but the head should bow.

Raghib says “رُكُوعٌ” (*rukuh*) means to bow. This word is spoken sometimes to bow physically and sometimes used for humility and submission whether that be in worship or not.

“رَكَعَ الشَّيْخُ” (*raka ash sheikh*): an old man, because in old age one bends a little due to weakness. If a man's condition becomes weak then too it is said “رَكَعَ فُلَانٌ” (*raka'a fulan*).

Ibn Faris too has said that it means to bow.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that in the era before the advent of Islam, the Arabs used to call a man “رَاكِعٌ” (*rakiun*) when he was not a worshipper of idols. Then they would say “رَاكِعٌ إِلَى اللَّهِ” (*rakiun ilal lah*) to him which means “the one who does not bend”

Zamkhashri has said that it means “he was content to turn towards Allah” {T}.

“رَاكِعٌ” (*raakiun*) has the plural as “رُكَّاعٌ” (*rukka-un*).

“رُكُوعٌ” (*ruku-un*) and “سُجُودٌ” (*sujud*) actually means to bow in submission to Allah's laws. In “سُجُودٌ” (*sujud*), there is more intensity (of submission) than “رُكُوعٌ” (*ruku-un*), i.e. total submission and obedience. See heading (S-J-D).

In surah *Al-Baqrah* the Jews have been told:

2:43	the group which is genuflecting before Allah, you too join them and follow My laws like them	وَأَقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآتُوا الزَّكَاةَ وَارْكَعُوا مَعَ الرَّاكِعِينَ
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Since man's movements are an indication of his emotions (for instance, when we say 'no', our head automatically turns from side to side and when we say 'yes' then it automatically moves up and down), the display of bowing before Allah's laws is done by “رُكُوعٌ” (*rukuh*) and “سُجْدَةٌ” (*sajdah*), i.e. by bending and genuflecting in prayer.

48:29	you see them in rukuh and sujud (bending and genuflecting)... the effects of their submission are evident from their faces	تَرَاهُمْ رُكَّعًا سُجَّدًا... سِيمَاهُمْ فِي وُجُوهِهِمْ مِنْ أَثَرِ السُّجُودِ
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It is obvious that if a person bends and genuflects before Allah, but he actually follows other laws, then his *rukuh* and *sujud* will not be according to Allah's will, i.e. for a few minutes, he bends before Allah, but in his entire practical life he follows ungodly laws. Therefore his *rukuh* and *sujud* are not a true indication of his subservience to Allah. True *rukuh* and *sujud* are such that a man's heart submits to Allah's laws and along with his heart his head bends before Allah as well. This is what is desired by the congregations of prayer.

“الرَّكْمُ” (*ar-rakm*): to put things over each other and to build them into a layer by layer heap.

“فَيَرْكُمُهُ” (*fayarkumuhu*): he will turn them into a heap (8:37).

“رُكَّامٌ” (*rukaam*): a heap of layer by layer {T, M, R}.

24:43	then they are turned into layer upon layer of cloud	ثُمَّ يَجْعَلُهُ رُكَّامًا
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52:44	layer upon layer of cloud	سَحَابٌ مَّرْكُومٌ
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“نَاقَةٌ مَّرْكُومَةٌ” (*naaqatun markumatun*) is a camel which is very plump, which has layer upon layer of fat in its body {T, M, R}.

R-K-N ر ك ن

“رَكِنٌ” (*rakin*), “يَرْكُنُ” (*yarkan*): to lean towards someone and attain peace {T, M, R}.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:113	Do not lean towards the rebellious people. (Do not be attracted to them)	وَلَا تَرْكُنُوا إِلَى الَّذِينَ ظَلَمُوا
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Surah *Bani Israel*:

17:47	If We had not kept you firm then you might have leaned a little towards them	وَلَوْلَا أَن تَبَتُّنَا لَقَدْ كِدْتَ تَرْكُنُ إِلَيْهِمْ شَيْئًا قَلِيلًا
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Messengers of Allah do not bend (from their stand), even though an ordinary man may (may it be for his mission's sake) bend a little. See 68:9 and 10:15.

“الرُّكْنُ” (*ar-rukn*): a thing which strengthens someone, support {T, R, M}.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is strength.

“رُكْنٌ” (*rukn*) means the strongest element or part of a thing.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:80	let me take the help of a strong support	أَوَيْتُ إِلَى رُكْنٍ شَدِيدٍ
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Ibn Faris says “رُكْنٌ شَدِيدٌ” (*rukun shaded*) means respect and overpowering due to which nobody has the courage for opposition.

“أَرْكَانُ الشَّيْءِ” (*arkaanash shaiyi*): a thing's surroundings, the supports of that thing.

R-M-H ر م ح

“الرَّمْحُ” (*ar-rumh*) means spear. Its plural is “رِمَاحٌ” (*rimah*) {T, R, M}.

The Quran says:

5:94	that which your hands and your spears can reach	تَنَالُهُ أَيْدِيكُمْ وَرِمَاحُكُمْ
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Figuratively also this word “الرَّمْحُ” (*ar-rumh*) is used to mean poverty and starvation {M}.

Taj-ul-Uroos has mentioned it as “رَمَاحٌ” (*rammah*) instead of “رُمَحٌ” (*rumh*).

R-M-D ر م د

Ibn Faris says anything that is colored ash or dust is called “الْأَرْمَدُ” (*al-armadu*).

“الرَّمَادُ” (*ar-ramaad*) means ashes {T, R, M}.

“رَمَادَةٌ” (*ramadah*): annihilation, destruction.

“أَرْمَدَ الْقَوْمَ” (*armadal qaum*): people faced drought and their animals were destroyed.

The Quran has likened the deeds of those who tread the wrong path as “رَمَادٌ” (*ramaad*) over which strong wind blows. Obviously if strong winds blow, ashes do not leave even a trace and are scattered. Wrong systems and deeds can't stand the strong currents of the times and like a heap of ashes which may seem to be very big, disperses easily.

R-M-Z

ر م ز

“الرَّمْزُ” (*ar-ramz*) means movement {M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means movement or unease.

“الرَّمِيزُ” (*ar-rameez*): means with a lot of movement {T}, this leads to its meaning signals, be it by lips, eyes, brows, mouth, hand or by the tongue, but there is no sound. Even if there is a sound it must be very low like that of whispering.

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says about *Zakariyah*:

3:40	you will not be able to talk to people for three days except in sign (language)	أَلَّا تُكَلِّمَ النَّاسَ ثَلَاثَةَ أَيَّامٍ إِلَّا رَمْزًا
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In the traditions of the Jews, even talking was prohibited during fasting, or there was fasting in which the intent was to abstain from speaking. See 19:26.

“الرَّمْضُ” (*ar-ramz*): means for sand etc. to heat up in the sunlight.
 “الرَّمْضُ” (*ar-ramzu*), “الرَّمْضَاءُ” (*ar-ramza’u*): intense heat {T}.
 “شَهْرُ رَمَضَانَ” (*shahru ramazaan*): the month of **Ramadan**.

In ancient Arabic, this month was called “نَاتِقٌ” (*naatiq*), when the names of the months were changed (that too was before the advent of Islam) this month was called “رَمَضَانُ” (**Ramadan**) because it fell in the months of intense heat {T}.

The Quran began to be revealed during this month (2:185).

According to the lunar year, no month can fall in the same season every year. Hence this month of **Ramadan** can fall in winter as well as in summer, but it is called “رَمَضَانُ” (**Ramadan**) nevertheless. See heading (N-S-A).

“رَمَّ الْعَظْمُ” (*rammal azm*): the bone became aged, and purified.
 “رَمَّ الشَّيْءَ رَمًّا وَارْتَمَهُ” (*rammash shaiyi ramman wur tammah*): he ate the thing completely.
 “الرَّمَّةُ” (*ar-rimmah*): old bones.
 “الرُّمَّةُ” (*ar-rummah*): old rope, whatever is left of the past year’s plants.
 “الرَّمِيمُ” (*ar-ramim*): any old and decrepit thing.
 “الرَّمُّ” (*ar-rimmu*): broken or mashed dry grass, the garbage which floats on the surface of the water.
 “الرِّمَامُ” (*al-irmaam*): to become quiet, silence.
 “الرَّمُّ” (*ar-rammu*): to mend a decrepit thing {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris has four basic meanings for it.

- 1) To mend or correct something
- 2) For a thing to become decrepit
- 3) To be quiet
- 4) To talk (this word means the opposites of the above).

The noble Quran says:

36:78	When the bones become decrepit, then who can make them live again?	مَنْ يُحْيِي الْعِظَامَ وَهِيَ رَمِيمٌ
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Surah **Zaariyaat** says about the destructive storm that had blown on the nation of **Aad**:

51:42	It did not spare anyone who came within its range and whoever did was reduced to smithereens (sawdust).	مَا تَذَرُ مِنْ شَيْءٍ أَنْتَ عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا جَعَلْتَهُ كَالرَّمِيمِ
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“الرُّمَّانُ” (*ar-rummaan*): pomegranate, whether tree or the fruit. Singular is “رُمَّانَةٌ” (*rummanah*), probably due to the effect which it has on the heart (it calms it down).
 “رَمَنَ بِالْمَكَانِ” (*raman bilmakaan*): he resided there {T, M}.

The Quran has mentioned orchards of grapes, olives and pomegranates:

6:100	In jannat (heavenly society) there shall be grapes,	وَجَنَّاتٍ مِنْ أَعْنَابٍ وَالزُّيُّونَ وَالرُّجَّانَ
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	olives and pomegranates	
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“رَمَى الشَّيْءَ” (*ramash shaiyi*), “رَمَى بِهِ” (*rami behi*): to throw something or lay it aside i.e. to discard.
 “رَمَى السَّهْمَ عَنِ الْقَوْسِ” (*ramas sahma unil qaus*): shot the arrow from the bow.
 “الرَّمَامَةُ” (*al-mirmah*): small arrow.
 “خَرَجَ يَرْتَمِي” (*kharaja yartami*): he went out to hunt with his bow.
 “الرَّمَى” (*al-marma*): the target {T}.

Surah *Al-Murselaat* says:

77:33	it throws sparks	إِنَّهَا تَرْمِي بِشَرِّ
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Surah *Al-Feel* says:

105:3	you stoned them	تَرْمِيهِمْ بِحِجَارَةٍ
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Surah *Al-Anfaal* says:

8:17	The shooting of arrows which was taking place from your side in the battle of Badar was actually being shot by Allah.	وَمَا رَمَيْتْ إِذْ رَمَيْتْ وَلَكِنَّ اللَّهَ رَمَى
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All these battles were fought for establishing the supremacy of Allah's system. When a commander fights a battle at the command of a government, he fights the battle on behalf of the government, or when the army attacks the enemy, the attack is deemed as an attack by the commander.

If “رَمَيْتْ” (*ramait*) is followed by different verbs, it has different meanings but here the talk is about battle and it has been made clear by saying “فَلَمْ تَقْتُلُوهُمْ” (*falam taqtuluhum*) that here the killing of the enemies has been talked about. Therefore, “رَمَيْتْ” (*ramait*) would mean shooting arrows.

William Lane has written with different references, that when “رَامَيْتُهُ” (*ramaituhu*) or “مُرَامَاهُ” (*muramah*) appears alone, it means archery or stoning.

“رَمَاهُ بِقَبِيحٍ” (*ramahu beqabeeh*): he linked her to evil {T}.

The Quran says:

24:33	Those who accuse puritan women, to accuse some puritan woman is worse than shooting arrows at her or stoning her	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَرْمُونَ الْمُحْصَنَاتِ
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That is why the Quran has suggested very strong punishment for this crime (24:2).

“رَاحَ” (*rah*), “رَوْحَ” (*rauh*), “رُوحَ” (*rooh*), “رَيْحَ” (*reeh*): these all derived from the same root, and from it are also “رَاحَهُ” (*rahah*), “رَوْحَهُ” (*rauhah*), “إِسْتِرَاحَهُ” (*istiraha*), “تَرَوِيحَهُ” (*tarviha*), “رَيْحَانُ” (*raihaan*) etc.

“رَاحَ” (*rah*) basically means for the wind to blow, to feel the air {T}. Since air (wind) creates happiness for humans, has movement and strength, therefore all these connotations are included in words derived from its root.

Ibn Faris says it basically means vastness, expanse or large heartedness.

“الرَّوْحُ” (*ar-rauh*) means comfort, bliss, happiness, benevolence, vastness.

“مَكَانُ رَوْحَانِي” (*makanun rauhaani*): a good and pure house {T}.

“الرَّيْحُ” (*ar-reeh*): wind.

“الرَّيْحَةُ” (*ar-reeha*): some part of the wind. “رِيَّاحُ” (*riyah*) is its plural.

Raghib says the Quran has used “رِيَّاحُ” (*riyah*) to mean benevolence and happiness at various places, and “رَيْحَ” (*reeh*) for punishment.

Lataif-ul-Lugha says that when “الرَّيْحُ” (*ar-reeh*) or the wind is strong, it is called “الْعَاصِفُ” (*al-aasif*).

“مُبَشِّرَاتُ” (*mubash shiraat*): that wind which brings clouds.

“الْمُعْصِرَاتُ” (*al-mu'seeraat*): those winds which bring rain.

“عَاصِفُ” (*aasif*): winds in the valleys and deserts, or devastating winds.

“الْقَوَاصِفُ” (*al-qawasif*): those winds which raise a storm in the sea.

“الرَّيْحُ” (*reeh*): victory, power and overpowering, circulation, revolution, and turn {T}.

8:26	You will be out of wind, (your strength will be lost)	وَتَذْهَبَ رِيحُكُمْ
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“تَرَوِيحُهُ” (*tarviha*): to sit and rest, to take a rest. Later it means the four sections prayer of *taraveeh* because after every four sections of it, there is a short rest period.

“الرَّوِيحَةُ” (*ar-raviha*): to get some ease after constriction.

“رَاحَهُ” (*raaha*): for the cattle to come back home in the evening for rest.

“الرَّوَّاحُ” (*ar-rawah*) means evening or the period from when the sun starts setting till evening {T}.

In surah *Saba*, “رَوَّاحُ” (*rawah*) or evening journey appears opposite to “غُدُوُّ” (*ghuduw*) or morning journey (34:12).

The *Muheet* says “الرَّوْحُ” (*ar-rauh*) means besides happiness and comfort and benevolence, also breeze and help.

It also means justice which gives the prosecution contentment and peace.

“الرَّوْحُ” (*ar-rooh*) means the human soul, as well as benevolence and revelation from God, and the noble Quran itself {M}. In verse 16:2, the meaning of “الرَّوْحُ” (*ar-rooh*) means Revelation. In Surah *Ash-Shura* verse 42:52, “رُوحًا” (*roohan*) means the noble Quran itself.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:85	they ask you about ar-rooh, tell them that ar-rooh is my Sustainers concern	وَيَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ الرُّوحِ مِنَ أَمْرِ رَبِّي
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Here “الرَّوْحُ” (*ar-rooh*) does not mean human soul, but Revelation, or Quran itself. The next verse explains this when it says “أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْكَ” (*auhaina ilaika*). The meaning is that these people want to know about what revelation is, tell them that it is a matter that belongs to the meta-physical world, it has no

connection with the physical world so you cannot comprehend it even if you were to be explained. You will have to believe in it regardless, although you can understand its teachings.

They wanted to know about Revelation, and what the relationship between God and his Messenger is, etc. These things cannot be understood by someone who is not a messenger {*Al-Minar*}.

“رُوحُ الْقُدُسِ” (*ruhul qudus*) as appeared in 2:87 means whose strength was available to *Isa* and which was the orders in *Torah* and *Bible* which he was endowed with through revelation. And which were the cause that a human being became exalted. Some think that “رُوحُ الْقُدُسِ” (*ruhul qudus*) means *Jibrael* and have taken “رُوحُ الْأَمِينِ” (*ruhul amin*) (26:193) to mean the same. {*Al-Minar*}.

Here the Quran has been said to be:

26:193	the trusted Spirit descended with it on your heart	نَزَلَ بِهِ الرُّوحُ الْأَمِينُ عَلَى قَلْبِكَ
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This is supported by the verse of surah *Al-Baqrah* in which it is said about *Jibreel*:

2:97	Then indeed we brought it down on your heart by the announcement of Allah	فَإِنَّهُ نَزَّلَهُ عَلَى قَلْبِكَ بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ
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This clearly shows that “رُوحُ الْأَمِينِ” (*ruhul amin*) is another title of “جبريل” (*Jibreel*).

Surah *An-Nahal* says “قُلْ نَزَّلَهُ رُوحُ الْقُدُسِ” (*qul nazzalahu ruhul qudus*) in 16:102, thus “رُوحُ الْقُدُسِ” (*ruhul qudus*) also means *Jibreel*. Since we cannot understand what Revelation is, we also cannot understand what *Jibreel* is. The word “الرُّوحُ” (*ar-rooh*) points it to be a metaphysical being which reveals the Quran unto the Messenger’s heart, and “مَلَائِكَةٌ” (*malaika*) are those forces of nature in the universe which bear witness to God’s being.

Therefore the Quran has used the terms *malaikah* and *rooh* separately as in 97:4, 78:38 and 70:4.

The initial links in the Quran about the creation of Man are the same as those which are known about common animals, but after that the humans have been elevated by saying:

32:9	God breathed His soul into it	وَنَفَخَ فِيهِ مِنْ رُوحِهِ
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And the result has been said to be:

32:9	The humans were endowed with eyesight and hearing	وَجَعَلْ لَكُمْ السَّمْعَ وَالْأَبْصَارَ وَالْأَفْئِدَةَ
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This means that the means of gathering knowledge were induced in the mind and heart. It is obvious that here God’s breath is that Godly strength which is known as personality or one’s self, and which determines a man’s characteristics. This self has been granted equally to each human being. It remains to be seen to what extent a man then develops it to. This is known as spiritualism and this development takes place only in an Islamic society.

Here it must be understood why God has called this ‘force’ as our soul. Is it a manifestation of God’s personality? There are forces everywhere in the universe. They are more pronounced and visible in living things, this force is the result of materialist cause and effect, (or it comes into being as a consequence of physical laws). That is why it is called physical force. Human energy can also be classified under it, but humans have another sort of energy too which is manifested through his intent and authority. This force is stronger than the physical force and the physical force is subservient to it. This superior force has been attributed by God towards Himself. He has called it “روحنا” (*rohna*) or God’s soul or force. What is meant to portray by this is that this force has no connection with the physical laws, but has been given to us directly by God. This is the character of human personality, and is attributed to divine force.

“الوحياتى” (*aluhiati*) means a force which is not the product of matter but attributable directly to God. It must be noted here that the force which is not “الوحياتى” (*aluhiati*) or divine is also created by no other than God. But it is created as per the laws which have been formulated by God in regard to matter. The human energy He has attributed to Himself in order to discriminate it from the physical forces.

This force is not a part of God's personality. The personality cannot be divided into parts; to think that it is a part which has separated from God, is a Hindu philosophy and a concept out of *Vedant*. Human personality is a gift of God which is not part of His overall personality, nor is its ultimate aim to reunite with the whole. This force is received in an undeveloped form and to develop it is the purpose of human life.

For this reason the Quranic society is formulated. Every human deed has an effect on his personality, and his personality does not end with the death of his corporeal self. The basic difference in the materialistic concept of life and the Quranic concept is this very thing. The materialistic concept believes that this corporeal self is all there is, that the machinery of this corporeal self is kept in motion by physical laws and when they cease to function then that individual is finished. According to the Quranic concept, human life consists of his corporeal self and his personality. His personality is not subject to physical laws, and therefore when the corporeal being ceases to function, even then nothing happens to his personality, it lives beyond.

Just as there are laws according to which a human body develops, so are there laws according to which a man's personality develops. These principals are called Permanent Values and are not a product of human intellect. They are received through Revelation and are now safe in the Quran. The difference between the developments of the two is that man's body develops when he himself eats or uses things, but the personality develops when a man helps others to develop. According to the Quran, the system of Quranic welfare is built on this very basis. As the human personality develops, it starts reflecting more and more the divine qualities (to a human extent, of course). More details can be found under heading (N-F-S).

The Quran has nowhere talked about the human "soul", but has always talked about the "soul of God". When this "God's soul" or the divine force is endowed to man, then in Quranic terms it is called "نفس" (*nafs*) as in 91:74-79. This is what is known as the human personality, Self or Ego.

When we say that the purpose of human life is the development of its personality, it does not mean that the human body and its development have no significance. According to the Quran the development of the human body is also very important because at the present level the human personality is developed through the development of the human body. As such, it is as important for the human body to be as healthy as for an egg to be healthy enough to become a strong chick. Although if it so happens that there is a tie between the interests of the body and the personality, then it is wiser to sacrifice the interest of the body over that of personality, as it becomes a test for belief and human dignity, just like the chick which breaks the shell when it gets too big for the eggshell. This is the essence of Quranic teachings, that is, to sacrifice physical demands for permanent values whenever there is a tie between them, this is what character building is.

The Quran has also used "الرَّيْحَانُ" (*ar-raihaan*) as in surah *Ar-Rahman*:

55:12	corn on the stalk, and aromatic crops	وَالْحَبُّ ذُو الْعَصْفِ وَالرَّيْحَانُ
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"الرَّيْحَانُ" (*ar-raihan*) is a sort of fragrant grass, also initial vegetation if it is sweet smelling and flowering.

Faraa has said that the stalks are called "عَصْفُ" (*asf*) and their leaves "رَيْحَانُ" (*rehaan*).

"الرَّيْحَانُ" (*ar-raihaan*) also means progeny and sustenance.

"أَرَاهُ" (*arah*): he rested, left the cattle to rest in the pen in the evening.

“رَوْدُ” (*raud*): to come and go several times in quest of something, that is, to keep searching for something, to be continuously in movement.

“الرَّائِدُ” (*ar-ra'id*): means the handle of a grind wheel,

“رَائِدُ الْعَيْنِ” (*raa-idul ain*): the straw in the eye which keeps moving from one place to another {T, M}

“الْمَرَادُ” (*al-maraad*): the place or path where camels come and go, this path is called “رِيَادُ الْإِبِلِ” (*riyaadul ibl*).

“الرَّائِدُ” (*ar ra-id*): the man who is sent ahead of the caravan to look for water or fodder {T, M}.

Since “رَوْدُ” (*raud*) has the connotation to strive or struggle for something, “إِرَادَةُ” (*iraadah*) came to mean to desire something. But then “إِرَادَةُ” (*iradah*) and demand were differentiated that desire is manifested by a man's talk or deed, but “إِرَادَةُ” (*iradah*) is sometimes undisclosed and sometimes disclosed {T}.

“إِرَادَةُ” (*iradah*) actually means for the heart to be drawn towards something or hidden intent, or such leaning as a result of which some benefit is expected {M}

Raghib says “إِرَادَةُ” (*iradah*) means a force which includes desire, need, and wish, all, thereafter it also means for the heart to be drawn towards something or for decision only {R}. This led to “رَاوَدَهُ” (*ra-awdah*) meaning wanted him, or asked for him time and time again. If it is followed by “عَنْ” (*un*), then it means to demand a thing of someone against his willingness, as in 16:12 where it is related about **Yusuf's** brethren who said:

12:61	We will ask for him against his father's will (our father does not want us to take Yusuf with us but we will ask for him against his wishes)	سَنُرَاوِدُ عَنْهُ أَبَاهُ
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“يُرِيدُ” (*yureed*): he intends, it has meant this in 36:23 that is:

36:23	If the Raham intends to give me some pain	إِنْ يُرِيدَنَّ الرَّحْمَنُ يُضُرَّ
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“رَاوَدَهُ عَنْ نَفْسِهِ وَعَلَيْهَا” (*rawaddahu un nafsehi wa alaiha*) means to deceive, to induce, to persuade {T, M}.

It also means to have the desire to have sex with someone {T, M}. This makes the meaning of the verses such as 12:32 and 54:37 clear. The first verse points to the wrong intentions of **Aziz's** wife towards **Yusuf**, and the second towards the wrong ways of the nation of **Lot**.

“ارْوَدَ فِي السَّيْرِ” (*arwada fis sair*): he traveled at a peaceful pace {T, M}.

From this it led to “رُوَيْدُ” (*ruwaid*) meaning to give time, breathing space.

The Quran has used “رُوَيْدًا” (*ruwaida*) in this meaning,

86:17	so give the Deniers some time, a little time	فَمَهَلِ الْكَافِرِينَ أَتَاهُمْ رُوَيْدًا
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God's intentions, which are mentioned at several places in the Quran, should not be taken as Man's intentions. Human intents are fulfilled and broken too. They are right and even wrong, are practical and sometimes while poetic at other times. But God's intentions are those truths according to which everything in the universe is working.

“الرَّوْعُ” (*ar-rau*): awe that is inspired by something's beauty or abundance.

“الرَّوْعَةُ” (*ar-rau'a*): awe, or the effect of something's beauty.

“الرَّوْعُ” (*ar-ru*): heart, fear and the place for palpitation {T, R}.

The Quran says:

11:74	When Ibrahim's heart overcame his surprise and palpitation	فَلَمَّا دَهَبَ عَنْ إِبْرَاهِيمَ الرَّغْوُ
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Rom روم

“الرَّومُ” (*ar-room*): the Roman Empire.

Surah Rom or Rome says in 30:2 that the Romans were overpowered. This is the tale about the defeat which the Romans suffered at the hands of the Persian king *Khusru Pervaiz*, in which, province after province of the Romans fell to the Persians, and this continued till 615 A.D. At the very time when the Romans were in a weak condition, the Quran predicted that in a few years they will overpower the Persians, as such in 624AD. *Herkel* not only took his areas back from the Persians but also entered Persia and destroyed their place of fire worship. This happened in the year 2 H when the Muslims were victorious for the first time in the battle of *Badr*. The closest opponents of the Arabs were Persians. When the Persians were overpowering, even the Romans, the Arabs were distraught and worried, but within a short period of time, the Arabs, due to the Quranic system, became so strong that neither the Persians nor the Romans could stand up to them. This was all due to the strength that their Faith gave them.

R-He-B رهـب

“رَهَبٌ” (*rahb*), “رُهْبٌ” (*roh*), “رَبٌّ” (*rah*), “رُهْبَةٌ” (*ruh*), “رَبَّةٌ” (*rah*), “رُهْبَانٌ” (*ruh*).

This root means a fear which has caution in it, like one is afraid of burning and that is why we fear fire.

“الرَّهْبُ” (*ar-rahib*): lion {T}. It also means to become weak.

“الرَّهْبُ” (*arrahbu*) “الرَّهْبِيُّ” (*ar-ruhba*) means a she-camel which is weak and tired after a journey.

“رَبَّ الْجَمَلِ” (*rahbal jamal*): camel rose or stood up but again sat down due to weakness {T}.

“الرَّهْبَانِيَّةُ” (*ar-rahbaaniyyah*): includes all elements such as fear, caution, weakness, etc. in monastic, i.e.

due to the fear of God, giving up all the pleasures of life [“الرَّهْبَانُ” (*al-arhaab*): birds who do not prey

{T} and thus become weak, this sort of puritan is called “الرَّاهِبُ” (*ar-raahib*), its plural is “رُهْبَانٌ”

(*ruhbaan*) in 9:31. Some think that “رُهْبَانٌ” (*ruhbaan*) is a Persian word, and it is a compound of the words “رُ” (*ruh*) and “بَان” (*baan*) which means a puritan {T}. This could be a Persian word because they too used to practise monasticism.

The Quran says:

7:116	they tried to frighten the people	وَأَسْتَرْهَبُوهُمْ
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Surah *Al-Hashar* says:

59:13	their fear of you is great	لَا أَنْتُمْ أَشَدُّ رَهْبَةً فِي صُدُورِهِمْ
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Here too “رَبَّةٌ” (*rahbah*) means fear.

Bani Israel were told:

2:41	you must fear Me only	إِنِّي أَنَا فَارْهَبُونِ
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To fear God means to fear the devastating results of violating God's laws and to uphold them and avoid rebelling against them.

“رَهْبًا” (*rahaba*) basically means to fear and avoid.

Surah **Al-Ambia** says that the prophets were wont to:

21:90	they used call on God (for help) to attain life's benefits	يَدْعُونَ تَارْغِبًا وَرَهْبًا
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This means that they used to call for help to attain life's benefits "رَغْبًا" (*raghaban*) and to avoid its unpleasantness "رَهْبًا" (*rahaban*). They used to refer towards Him in both cases. Obviously removing the ills and accruing the benefits are the emotions which motivate man or act as incentives for man.

Messengers used to obey the laws of God in both conditions, something which all *momins* should do as well. As far as "رَبَّانِيَّةً" (*rahbaniyaat*) or monasticism is concerned, that is, to give up on this world, the Quran says that it was created by the Christians themselves (it was not ordered by God) (57:27).

Along with it, the Quran has said:

57:27	then they could not fulfill even this self-created condition	فَمَا رَعَوْهَا حَقَّ رِعَائِهَا
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This is what the Quran says about monasticism and which is the basis of Sufism and which (unfortunately) is considered to be our respectable Deen! When the Muslims let go of the Quran then all those ungodly elements to remove which the Quran had been sent, became part of Islam one by one. The total aneurism of the Romans, the racism of the Persians, the religious leadership and traditionalism of the Jews, and the monasticism of the Christians, all became part of Islam! Nowadays Islam is thought to be an amalgamation of all these! But this is no cause for hopelessness because God's *Deen* (way of life) is safe and intact with us within the Quran. As such, we can easily separate pure Deen from these adulterations, if we really intend to do so.

R-He-Th ر ه ط

"الرَّهْبُ" (*ar-rah*): someone's nation, tribe. Some say that "رَهْبٌ" (*rah*) is the party which has a membership of three to ten or seven to ten, but some say it is said even for less numbers or more but only men are included in it, not women.

Ibn Faris says it means a congregation of humans etc.

Surah **Hoodh** says:

11:92	brotherhood or tribe	رَهْطٌ
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Surah **An-Nahal** says about the nation of *Samood*:

27:48	and there were nine men who used to raise chaos in the city	وَكَانَ فِي الْمَدِينَةِ تِسْعَةُ رَهْطٍ يُفْسِدُونَ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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It is a reference to the leaders of the nation who held the reins of power, every nation, government or country is ruled by some people in power and who are responsible for creating the imbalance in the country, and the rest of the country is destroyed by them.

R-He-Q ر ه ق

"رَهَقَ" (*rahiqah*), "يَرَهَقُ" (*yarhaquhu*), "رَهَاقًا" (*rahaqa*): to cover something or overshadow it. *Raghib* has added, with force. It means as well to join with something, to overtake it and besiege it {*T, R*}.

10:26	Their faces do not turn bleak	وَلَا يَزِيدُهُمْ وُجُوهَهُمْ قَتَرٌ
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“رَبَقَةً” (*arhaqahu*): he forced him to do something beyond his power, put him into difficulty {M}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:80	Make rebellion overpower them. (or involve them in rebellion)	يُرْهِمُهُمَا طُغْيَانًا
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“رَبَقٌ” (*rahaq*): foolishness, nonsense, impoliteness, harshness, commitment of evil deed {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it means cheating, hastiness and oppression,

72:6	so they increased their unawareness	فَزَادُوهُمْ رَهَقًا
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Azhari says it actually has been derived from “رَبَاقٌ” (*irhaaq*) which means to coerce a man for doing that of which he is not capable {T, R}.

74:17	I will involve him in great difficulty or stress	سَأُرْهِمُهُ صَعُودًا
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R-He-N ر ه ن

“الرَّهْنُ” (*ar-rah*): Something which is kept as a guarantee for something that you have taken temporarily. “رِهَانٌ” (*rihaan*) is plural of “الرَّهْنُ” (*ar-rah*). It also means a guarantee. In the dictionary “رَهْنٌ” (*rahn*) means proof and stability (to be stolid).

Raghib says “رَهْنٌ” (*rahn*) and “رِهَانٌ” (*rihaan*) are things which are kept as guarantee for a loan, but “الرَّهْنَانُ” (*ar-rihaan*) is a thing which is kept as a guarantee in a bet. It is usually used in horseracing.

“الرَّاهِنُ” (*ar-raahin*): proven and ready, stolid and permanent.

“رَهْنُ الشَّيْءِ” (*rahanash shaiyi*): the thing remained stolid {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to stick to one thing whether it is right or wrong.

“رَجْلُهُ رَهِينَةٌ” (*rijluhu rahina*): his foot is imprisoned or trapped {T}.

“أَنَا رَهِينٌ بِكَذَا” (*anaraheen bikaza*): I am involved in that thing {M}.

The Quran says:

52:21	everybody is hostage to his deeds (his life is dependent upon his deeds for results)	كُلُّ امْرِئٍ بِمَا كَسَبَ رَهِينٌ
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In surah *Al-Baqarah*, the advice that is given for lending says that if you are traveling and find no one to write down (the loan agreement) then:

2:283	you must hold onto something as mortgage for the things that are lent	فَرِهْنٌ مَّقْبُوضَةٌ
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To make this the basis for ‘keeper’s property’ is an injustice (to God’s laws), for example, a farmer takes a loan from somebody and mortgages some of his land for it. Thereafter the land will remain with the lender who will own the produce of the land till the loan is returned and will not even deduct the cost of the produce from the loan. If this is not a type of interest, then what is it? This means that it is indeed a type of interest, which is forbidden.

“الرَّهْوُ” (*ar-rahwu*): the space between the two legs, a place where water accumulates, also peace which is tranquil.

“الرَّهَاءُ” (*arraha-u*): level and expansive land.

“عَيْشٌ رَاهٍ” (*aishun rah*): a content and peaceful life.

“الرَّهْوَانُ” (*ar-rahwaan*): low land, a horse whose back while riding is soft {*T, R*}.

Kitab-ul-Ishteqaaq says that this word means the opposites, that is “هبوط” (*haboot*) or to come down, as well as “ارتفاع” (*irtafaa*), or to go up.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings. One is of peace and contentment, and second is of a place which becomes high sometimes and at others becomes low. The Quran says when *Moosa* was taking along the nation of *Bani Israel* then he was told:

42:24	to leave the sea in a calm state	وَأَتْرَكَ الْبَحْرَ زَهُوًّا
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One meaning of this is verse is:

When *Moosa* reached it, the sea was peaceful, it was in ebb and it had receded and left some dry land behind.

Surah *Taha* says:

20:77	for them take the dry path in the sea	فَاضْرِبْ لَهُمْ طَرِيقًا فِي الْبَحْرِ يَبَسًا
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Even if “رَهْوًا” (*rahwa*) is taken to mean broad or expansive, it will mean the path which has been broadened by the sea (by receding), take them by that way. The place where there was the sea at first would be low, when the sea recedes from there, then that land will be (as compared to the land which is still under water) be higher.

“رَوْضَةٌ” (*rauzah*): the land where there are beautiful flowers, trees and water, beautiful garden with a canal, any green place which has a canal adjacent to it. The plural forms are “رَوْضٌ” (*rauzun*), “رِيَاضٌ” (*riyazun*) and “رَوْضَاتٌ” (*rauzaat*). If there is no water, then it is not called “رَوْضَةٌ” (*rauzah*). It is a place where water collects.

“أَرَادَ الْقَوْمَ” (*aradal qaum*): he watered the whole nation, i.e, he benefited the entire nation.

“الرِّيَاضَةُ” (*ar-riyazah*): to make somebody work hard to make him an expert at it, to train {*T, R*}.

Ibn Faris contends that its basic meanings contain vastness and expanse, as well as to soften something or to make some chore easier.

The Quran says:

30:15 42:22	they will enjoy music in a green spot	فَهُمْ فِي رَوْضَةٍ يُحْبَرُونَ
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Its plural is “رَوْضَاتٌ” (*rauzaat*).

“رَاغَ الرَّجُلُ” (*raghal rajulu*), “رَوَّغاً” (*ragha*): for some expedience, to turn to one side quietly, lean or to avoid {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to lean and not to remain in one state.

“رَاغَ فُلَانٌ إِلَى فُلَانٍ” (*raagha fulanun ila fulaan*): that man secretly leaned towards him.

Faraa says that “رَاغَ إِلَى أَهْلِهِ” (*raagha ila ahlehi*) means that he returned to his family and kept the purpose of his coming back hidden from others.

“أَرَاغَ” (*aragha*), “إِرَاغَةً” (*iraagha*), “أَرْتَاغَ” (*wartaagha*): he intended and demanded.
“رِوَاغَةً” (*riwagha*), “رَبَاغَةً” (*ruyagha*): ring (as in boxing or wrestling) {T, R, M}.

In the tale of **Ibrahim**, the Quran relates “فَرَاغَ إِلَى إِلَهِتِهِمْ” (*faraagha ila aalihatihim*) in 37:91 and “فَرَاغَ عَلَيْهِمْ” (*faragha alaihim*) in 37:93. “رَاغَ إِلَى” (*ragha ila*) means to keep your intentions to yourself while attending to someone, and “رَاغَ عَلَى” (*raagha ala*) means to attack somebody overwhelmingly. As such, **Ibrahim's** tact was such that it contained the element of secrecy of intent and overpowering strength as well.

“رَيْبٌ” (*raib*): actually it means psychological confusion, and uneasiness of “نَفْسٌ” (*nafs*) {*Aqrabal Muwarid*}.

It also means doubt, and restlessness {*T*}, also guess or opinion and accusation {*T, R, M*}. Besides it, it also means the vicissitudes of life and need {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means doubt or doubt and fear.

“الرَّيْبُ” (*ar-raib*): anything which creates confusion. It also means need.

“رَابِي الأَمْرِ رَيْبًا” (*rabani al-amru raiba*): that matter put me in doubt {*T*}.

In surah *At-Taubah*, in the context of *Masjid-e-Zarar*, it is said:

9:110	restlessness and confusion	رَيْبٌ فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ
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In surah *Ibrahim* 14:9 and in surah *Saba* 34:54 and at other places, “مُرَيْبٌ” (*mureebun*) has come as an adjective of “شَكٌّ” (*shakk*), which means doubt.

“شَكٌّ مُرَيْبٌ” (*shakkun mureebun*): doubt which creates uneasiness and confusion. In 40:34 “مُرْتَابٌ” (*murtaab*) has appeared, that is, one who doubts. In 29:48 is “إِرْتَابٌ” (*irtaab*), that is, doubted.

Surah *At-Toor* says:

52:30	The vicissitudes of life which can be faced by realities but not by poetic or idealistic emotionalism.	رَيْبُ الْمُتَوَكِّلِينَ
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Therefore, “رَيْبٌ” (*raib*) would mean uneasiness of the mind due to doubt. The Quran has said about itself in the very beginning:

2:2	this is the code of life which leaves no doubt or create any confusion or unease in the minds (its teachings create complete peace and calm, it has no place for unease and confusion)	ذَٰلِكَ الْكِتَابُ لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ
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Aqrabal muwarid says that these meanings are cited for the word *ar-reebah*, because it is entirely based on logic and reasoning, and it is obvious that only reasoning can create complete peace, not by blind faith and superstitions.

“الرَّيشُ” (*ar-reesh*), “الرَّاشُ” (*ar-raash*): the feathers of the birds with which their bodies are covered {*T*}.

“الرَّيشُ” (*ar-rish*): human clothing and beautification. It also means wellbeing and economic freedom.

“رَاشٌ فَلَانًا” (*raasha fulaana*): helped him earn and strengthened him, corrected his condition and benefited him.

“رَاشٌ الرَّجُلُ” (*raashar rujul*): the man became rich and well to do {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says that the root basically means wellbeing, as well as the good things that one acquires in life.

The Quran says that your clothing covers your body and “رِيشًا” (*reeshan*), also adorns you (7:26).

The Quran not only presents the utilitarian aspect of things but also gives equal importance to their aesthetic values. The beauty in the universe is a manifestation of this aspect of the creator. This means utilitarian and aesthetic values in everything. A *momin*'s life too must be an embodiment of both these two aspects,

“رَيْعٌ” (*ree’a*): the projecting part of anything, also everything’s best and first part.

“رَاعِ الطَّعَامُ” (*ra’at tu-aamu*): there was an increased production of crop, the crop production increased, was in abundance.

“رَيْعٌ” (*ri’a*), “رَيْعٌ” (*ra’a*): high land or high place. Every path or the path between two mountains, also mountain.

“كَمْ رَيْعُ أَرْضِكَ” (*kum ree-u ardika*): how high is your land?

“الرَّيْعُ” (*ar-ree*): high dune, the high place of the valley along which water flows down, it is also used for church.

“رَيْعَانُ الشَّبَابِ” (*rai’aanus shabaab*): the early part of youth.

“نَاقَةٌ رَيْعَانَةٌ” (*naqaatun rai’aanatun*): a camel which gives a lot of milk {T}.

The Quran says:

26:128	Do you make a monument to yourself at every elevated place? (And that too unnecessarily?)	أَتَبْنُونَ بِكُلِّ رِيعٍ آيَةً تَعْبَثُونَ
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This means memorials are only for remembrance and have no utility as such. Only such things are good memorials which are beneficial to the coming generations.

“رَيْنٌ” (*rayn*): rust or dirt etc. {T}.

“رَانَ بَوَاهُ عَلَى قَلْبِهِ بَرَيْنٌ” (*raana hawahu ala qalbehi birayn*): his wishes controlled his heart.

“رَيْنٌ بِالرَّجُلِ” (*reyna bir rujul*): the man was so involved in the confusion that it became difficult to extricate himself. It also means liquor, because it overwhelms the intellect {M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to cover.

Quran says:

83:15	their deeds overwhelmed their hearts as rust	رَانَ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ مَا كَانُوا يَكْسِبُونَ
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Hearts are not sealed or close externally. A man’s own deeds act as seals and rust for the heart. This is what has been described as “خَتَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ” (*khatamallahu ala qulubihim*) in 2:7, because everything takes place according to the laws of God. The results of a man’s deeds, which occur due to the law of nature, is that the man loses the ability to think rightly. He is so submerged by surface emotions that the road to thinking is closed to him.

“الزَّبْدُ” (*az-zabad*): the foam that comes to the top of the water or other liquid {T}.

The Quran says:

13:17	The foam that mounts up to the surface...	زَبَدًا رَائِيًا
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“الزُّبْدُ” (*az-zubd*): cream which is later made into butter.

“تَزَبَّدَهُ” (*tazabbadah*): he took the gist {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means for a thing to be born out of another.

Raghib says that as a metaphor “زَبَدًا” (*zabadah*) is also for something which is in abundance.

“الزُّبْرُ” (*az-zubr*): to write.

“التَّزْبِيرَةُ” (*at-tazbirah*): writing.

“مِزْبَرٌ” (*mizbar*): pen.

“مَزْبُورٌ” (*maz-zaboora*): written material, book etc. {T}. The plural is “زُبُرٌ” (*zubur*).

Surah *An-Nahal* says that the messengers were sent with “الْبَيِّنَاتِ وَالزُّبُرِ” (*al-bayyinaati waz-zubur*) in 16:44, 26:196.

Here “زُبُرٌ” (*zubur*) means books. Similarly at other places i.e. “بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ وَالزُّبُرِ وَالْكِتَابِ الْمُنِيرِ” (*bilbayyinaati waz-zuburi wal kitaabil munir*) as in 35:25, 3:183, “زُبُرٌ” (*zubur*) is referred to the divine book providing guidance.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says:

21:105	Verily, We noted in <i>Zaboora</i> after the <i>ziker</i> (mention)	وَلَقَدْ كَتَبْنَا فِي الزَّبُورِ مِنْ بَعْدِ الذِّكْرِ
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Some say that here “زُبُورٌ” (*zubur*) means “the Book of the Psalms” revealed on *Dawood*, and “ذِكْرٌ” (*ziker*) means *Torah*. But *Saeed Bin Jabeer* says that “زُبُورٌ” (*zaboora*) means every Divine Book (Revelation), i.e. Torah, Bible, Quran. Any of these books is “زُبُورٌ” (*zaboora*) {T}.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:163	And we gave <i>Zaboora</i> to <i>Dawood</i>	وَأَتَيْنَا دَاوُدَ زَبُورًا
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If “زُبُورٌ” (*zaboora*) means the book which was given to *Dawood*, then it would not have been said “زُبُورًا” (*zaboora*) which means one book. It should have been “الزَّبُورُ” (*az-zaboora*) which is a proper noun for “the book”.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to read and write, and to strengthen or make something stolid.

Raghib says that any voluminous book is called “زُبُورٌ” (*zaboora*).

“الزُّبْرَةُ” (*az-zubrah*): a big piece of iron {T}. Its plural is “زُبُرٌ” (*zubar*) and “زُبُرٌ” (*zubur*) as used in 18:96. This led it to mean sects or separate groups, as in 23:53

Since “زُبُرٌ” (*zubur*) is the plural of “زُبُورٌ” (*zabur*), as in 23:53, therefore it can also be interpreted as separate books.

“الزَّابِنُ” (*az-zabn*): to push, to shut out, to remove something from someone.
 “الزَّابِنُ” (*az-zubun*): the one who pushes away someone with strong force.
 “نَاقَتُ زَبُونٍ” (*naaqatun zabun*): the she camel which kicks and pushes away who tries to milk her.
 “حَرْبُ زَبُونٍ” (*hurbun zaboon*): severe clash in an intense battle {T}. A battle is called “زَبُونٌ” (*zaboon*) because of its violence {*Kitab-ul-Ashfaq*}.

“الزَّابِنِيَّةُ” (*az-zibniyah*): every brave or courageous person may be a soldier. The plural is “زَبَانِيَّةٌ” (*zabaniyah*) as in 96:18. It is used for the fighters who go to war in defence of Righteousness.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for something to be thin, or fine.

“الزُّجْجُ” (*az-zujji*) the iron piece at the back of a spear, the point of the elbow
 “الزُّجَّاجُ” (*az-zujjaaj*): things made from glass, ceramics etc. Singular is “زُجَّاجَةٌ” (*zujajah*) {T, R}.

The Quran refers to the lamp:

24:35	...within it a lamp....	فِي زُجَّاجَةٍ
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It also means a glass covering or a chandelier.

When the glass is full, it is called “كَاسٌ” (*kaas*), and when empty, is called “زُجَّاجَةٌ” (*zujajah*) {*Latif-ul-Lugha* and *Fiqh-ul-Lugha*}.

“زَجَرَهُ” (*zajarah*), “يَزْجُرُهُ” (*azjuruh*), “زَجْرَانُ” (*zajran*), “إِزْدَاجَرَهُ” (*izdajarah*): he stopped him (from something) and prevented and scolded him. Actually it means to shout at someone with a view to drive away or audibly scold someone or to give someone a dressing down.

“زَجَرَ الْبَعِيرَ” (*zajarat ba-eer*): he scolded the camel and hushed it.

“الزَّجُورُ” (*az-zajor*): the she camel which cannot be milked unless shouted at, therefore this word has an element of scolding or talking harshly.

The Quran says:

37:2	Hence those who drive away with strength ...	فَالْإِجْرَاتِ زَجْرًا
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This means the party of those fearless men who scold (or chastise) the oppressive forces to stop them from their excesses. A little later in the same surah:

37:19	that will only be one chiding	فَأَتَمَّاهِ زَجْرَةً وَاحِدَةً
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Surah *Al-qamar* says:

54:4	which contains such things as prevent from excesses	مَا فِيهِ مُزْدَجَرٌ
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Still further ahead it is said:

54:9	they called him mad and ousted him chastising	بَجْنُونٍ وَازْدَجَرٍ
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Vested interests who have power and wealth always treat any messenger who calls them towards the Divine Guidance with contempt and arrogance.

“زَجَاةً” (*zajah*), “يَزْجُوهُ” (*yazjuhu*), “زَجْوَا” (*zajwa*), “وَأَزْجَى” (*wazja*), “إِزْجَاءً” (*iz ja'a*): to drive something (egg on) softly {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

24:43	Do you not reflect on the fact that God drives the clouds slowly and softly?	أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ يَزْجِي سَحَابًا
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“زَجَا أَمْرٌ” (*zajal amr*): the matter became easy and simple or straight forward.

“الْمُزْجَى” (*al-muzja*): Something in in small quantity {*T, R*}.

“بِضَاعَةٌ مُّزْجَاةٌ” (*biza'atun muzjah*): a little capital or a small saving (12:88) {*T, R*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to throw away something without any hesitation or to drive, which can be easily culled and sent along.

“بِضَاعَةٌ مُّزْجَاةٌ” (*biza'atun muzjah*): would mean a small sum which can easily be parted with and donated. Ave h

“زَحَزَحَهُ عَنْهُ” (*zahzahahu un*): removed it from him, put it to one side.

“هُوَ بِزَحَزَحٍ مِنْهُ” (*huwa bizahzahin minh*): he is at a distance from him.

“الزَّحْزَاخُ” (*az-zahzahu*): far, distant {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says these are its basic meanings.

The Quran says:

2:96	..but this will not save him from punishment...	وَمَا لَهُمْ يُخْرِجُوهُ مِنَ الْعَذَابِ
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Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says:

3:185	...only he who is saved from the fire..	فَمَنْ يُخْرِجْ عَنِ النَّارِ
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“زَحَفَ إِلَيْهِ زَحْفًا” (*zahafa ilaihi zahfa*): proceeded towards him, went forward towards him {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it means to keep marching forward.

“زَحَفٌ” (*zahfin*) means when a child moves forward by dragging on his bottom {*T*}. This word is also used to mean to move on the knees like children do {*M*}.

“زَحَفَ الْبَعِيرُ” (*zahafal ba-eer*): due to tiredness, the camel started to drag its feet {*T*}.

“الزَّحَافَةُ” (*azuh hafah*): reptiles, those creatures which crawl on ground, like a tortoise etc. {*M*}. Later it began to be used for the movement of armies because these, due to their size, move as if are dragging at a crawling pace.

“أَزْهَفُوا لَنَا بَنُو فُلَانٍ” (*azhafu lana banu fulaan*): that tribe came from the above stated condition to fight us.

“تَزَاهَفُوا فِي الْقِتَالِ” (*tazahafu fil qitaal*): they came face to face in battle.

“مَزَاهِفُ الْقَوْمِ” (*mazahiful qaum*): battle sites where a nation has fought battles {*T*}.

“الزَّحْفُ” (*az-zahf*): a brave army which is advancing towards an enemy.

Surah *Al-Anfal* says:

8:15	 when you meet the enemy in battle (when they are advancing towards you)	إِذْ لَقِيتُمُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا زَحْفًا
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Z-Kh-R-F ز خ ر ف

“الزُّخْرُفُ” (*az-zukhruf*): gold, which is used to make ornaments. This is its real meaning. Adornments were also called “زُخْرُفٌ” (*zukhruf*), and as a metaphor, for every exaggerated statements e.g. propaganda {*T, M*}.

“زُخْرُفٌ” (*zukhruf*) also used to explain the extreme beauty. In 43:35, this word means the things for adornment or adornment itself

The Quran says:

6:113	Decorative speech	زُخْرُفُ الْقَوْلِ
10:24	Until the earth takes its decoration	حَتَّىٰ إِذَا أَخَذَتِ الْأَرْضُ زُخْرُفَهَا

“زُخْرُفًا” (*zukhurufa*): cosmetic make up, or other things one uses for own objectification and projection.

Muheet doubts that it either means gold or adornment {*M*}.

Raghib says it means artificial beauty {*R*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means gold and also adornment. *Raghib* supports him on this.

Z-R-B ز ر ب

“الزَّرْبُ” (*az-zarb*): entrance, a wooden enclosure for keeping goats in, etc.

“الزَّرَابِيُّ” (*az-zarabi*): the singular is “زُرْبِي” (*zurbi*) or “زُرْبِيَّةٌ” (*zarbiyah*) which means mattresses, bedding, any such thing which is used to lean upon or get support.

“الزُّرْبِيَّةُ” (*az-zurbiyyah*): good carpet or flooring {*M*}.

Fara says that “زَرَابِي” (*zarabi*) means mattresses with frills. It is possible that this meaning may have developed with reference to “الزَّرَابِيُّ مِنَ النَّبْتِ” (*az-zarabiyyu minan nabt*) which means yellow and green plants which bear vegetables {*T*}.

Quran says:

88:16	floor covering of a high quality	زَرَابِيُّ مَبْثُوثَةٍ
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Ibn Faris says that “زَرْبٌ” (*zarb*) basically contains the connotation of some resting place.

Z-R-Ain ز ر ع

“زَرَغٌ” (*zara*), “يَزْرَعُ” (*yazra*), “زَرْعًا وَ” (*zaruw*), “زِرَاعَةٌ” (*zira'ah*): to put seed into the soil.

“الزَّرْعُ” (*az-zar'u*): to grow {*T*}.

“الزَّرَّاعُ” (*az-zurra*): those who till the soil, gardeners or farmers (48:29). The singular is “زَارِعٌ” (*zarih*).

“زَرْعٌ” (*zar'un*): crop, or what is produced by sowing {*T*} (6:141, 13:4).

Ibn Faris says with reference to *Khalil* that it basically means to develop or nurture something.

Therefore, as it will be explained later, it does not just mean to put seeds into the soil but also means to grow a crop. A man cultivates the land and sows the seeds and takes various precautions, but for the seeds to grow into a sapling and then into a plant is all according to Allah's laws and in this process no human effort is involved. That is why Allah has questioned:

56:64	Do you make the crops grow or it is Us?	ءَأَنْتُمْ تَزْرَعُونَهُ أَمْ نَحْنُ الزَّارِعُونَ
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The above verse explains that you only sow the seed while God's laws make it grow, thus how can you claim ownership of the entire produce ? Take what is due for your efforts and give Us Our share, i.e. give it to those who need it (56:73).

“الزَّرَقُ” (*az-zaraq*): blue color.

“الزَّرْقَةُ” (*az-zurqah*): bluish, whiteness, greenish color in the blackness of the eye, for whiteness to cover eye's blackness.

“زُرْقٌ” (*zariq*): his eyes' blackness was covered by whiteness. A person who has this is called “أَزْرَقُ” (*azraq*). Its plural is “زُرُقٌ” (*zurq*).

“الزَّرَقُ” (*az-zaraq*) means blondness.

“زَرَقْتُ عَيْنَهُ تَزْرُقُ” (*zariqat anhu tazraq*): for the eyes to turn blue {T}.

The Quran says:

20:102	On the day of judgment, We will raise the criminals as blind, their blackness of the eyes will be covered with whiteness	نَحْشُرُ الْمُجْرِمِينَ يَوْمَئِذٍ زُرْقًا
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“زُرُقٌ” (*zurq*) is plural and its singular is “أَزْرَقُ” (*azraq*).

Raghib says that “زُرْقًا” (*zurqa*) means blind whose eyes are bereft of sight {R}. Some linguists think that the Arabs had old enmity with the Romans and they were blue eyed. Thus every captive or enemy was called “أَزْرَقُ الْعَيْنِ” (*azraqul ain*) even though his eyes may not be blue {M, *Kashaf*}. But I think, the former meaning is more acceptable, because the Quran uses it in this context.

Later in the same surah, it is said:

20:124	..on the day of judgment we will raise them blind..	نَحْشُرُهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ أَعْمَى
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“زَرَىٰ عَلَيْهِ عَمَلَهُ” (*zara ilaihi amalehi*): to chastise someone for his deed, to dress him down, to criticize him, to demean him and to accuse him {T}.

“إِزْدَرَاهُ” (*izdarah*): considered him to be low and insignificant.

“إِزْدَرَاهُ” (*al-muzdari*): one who thinks someone as inferior. {M, *Kashaf*}.

The Quran says:

11:31	...those who are lowly in your eyes ...	تَزْدَرِي أَعْيُنُكُمْ
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“الزَّعْمُ” (*azza'am*), “الزُّعْمُ” (*az-zoam*), “الزَّعْمُ” (*az-zeem*): such a saying or utterance which could either be true or false, i.e. good or evil. But often it is used for things which are not true and not based on facts.

Lane has said when the Arabs say “نَكَرَ فُلَانٌ” (*zakara fulanun*) then it means that the matter talked about is true, but when there is doubt about the veracity of the saying, then it is said “زَعَمَ فُلَانٌ” (*za'ama fulan*). Some say that “زَعَمَ” (*za'am*) definitely means lie.

“الْتَرَعْمُ” (*at-taza'am*): to fabricate lies; linguists say “زَعَمُوا” (*za'amu*) means such things which have no authentication or proof, but are simply hear-say {T}. It includes the connotations of guesswork and expectation (may be true).

Muheet says “الرَّعْمُ” (*azza’am*) means doubtful talk or which is secretly believed to be false, some say talk without reasoning is “رَعْمٌ” (*za’am*). Some say it means to claim knowledge, some say that “رَعْمٌ” (*za’am*) means belief whether true or false {R}.

Raghib says that this word has always appeared in Quran when condemnation of the speaker is intended.

The Quran says:

64:7	The unbelievers think that they can't be raised....	رَعْمَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا أَنْ لَنْ يُبْعَثُوا
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In Surah *Al-Anam* says:

6:137	...false belief....	بِرَعْمِهِمْ
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“رَعْمَ بِهِ” (*za’ama bihi*): guaranteed it, accepted the responsibility for it.

“الرَّعِيمُ” (*az-za’eem*): responsible for and patron (68:40, 12:72).

Ibn Faris has said that the root has two basic meanings. Firstly to say something which has not been verified, and secondly to accept the responsibility for something and become its patron.

Z-F-R ز ف ر

“زَفَرَ” (*zafar*), “يَزْفِرُ” (*yazfir*), “زَفِيرًا” (*zafeera*): to take the breath out {T}.

Raghib says it means to breathe heavily, as while sobbing the breath comes and goes. It is mostly used for the initial gasping sound of a donkey’s braying. The last part of its voice is called “شَهيقٌ” (*shaheeq*), while “زَفِيرٌ” (*zafeer*) means to take the breath inside {T}.

The Quran has used both “زَفِيرٌ” (*zafeer*) and “شَهيقٌ” (*shaheeq*) together in the same sentence 11:106. It means to sob, to cry out loud 21:100. It also means the sound of a fire flaring up (25:13), and it is also used for an unexpected misfortune.

“الرَّزْقُ” (*az-zirq*): the load on one’s back, a traveller’s luggage, a skin container used by shepherds to store water, **Ibn Faris** says it can basically mean both, load and noise.

Z-F-F ز ف ف

“الرَّزْفُفُ” (*az-zafeef*) basically means for the wind to blow strongly, further the fast speed of an ostrich which is a combination of running fast along with flying {R}.

“رَفَّ النَّعِيرُ” (*zaffal ba-eer*): the camel moved faster.

“الرَّزْفُفُ” (*az-zafzaf*): a fast moving ostrich or a camel

“الرَّزْفُفُ” (*az-zafeef*) also means lightning.

“رَفَّ العُرُوسَ إِلَى زَوْجِهَا زَفًّا وَزَفَافًا” (*zaffal uroosa ila zaujihazaffa wa zifafa*): he presented the bride before the husband {T} (*Here the presenter’s eagerness is involved*).

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be fast and slick in everything.

The Quran says:

37:94	they came towards him with alacrity	فَأَقْبَلُوا إِلَيْهِ يَرْفُوفُونَ
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(*Here the emotive intensity is evident*).

“الزَّقْمُ” (*az-zaqm*): to take a mouthful, to swallow.

“أَزَقَمَهُ الشَّيْءُ” (*azqamahush shaiyi*): he gave him something as a mouthful and made him swallow {T}.

Raghib says “زَقَمَ” (zaqam) and “تَزَقَّمَ” (tazaqqam) means to swallow something unpleasant {R}.

“الزَّقُومُ” (*az-zaqqoom*): means a wild plant which is bitter tasting and its small, round leaves are very ugly and it has big knots in its stalk.

The Quran says:

37:65	The shoots of its fruit-stalk are like the heads of devils.	طَلْعُهَا كَأَنَّهُ رُئُوسُ الشَّيَاطِينِ
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It is obvious why the Quran has used it as an allegory for a mental state of individuals.

Soalub has said that “الزَّقُومُ” (*az-zaqqoom*) means every edible thing that is poisonous and can kill {T}.

Muheet says that it is used when a person eats or does something that becomes a bane for him.

The Quran declares:

37:64	the tree that grows at the base of a hellish society	إِنَّهَا شَجَرَةٌ تَخْرُجُ فِي أَصْلِ الْجَحِيمِ
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It is obvious that this does not refer to an actual tree as no tree can grow in the fires of hell. It signifies such sustenance which may turn humanity into a very unhappy state of living in this world. It refers to powerful and rich people as long branches of the tree and their means of sustenance obtained through oppressive means. This has also been pronounced “شَجَرَةٌ مَلْعُونَةٌ” (*shajaratun mal-oonah*) in 17:60 and “طَعَامُ الْآثِمِينَ” (*tu'aamul aseem*) in 42:44. That is, such sustenance which makes a man weak and his potentials are stultified, and he is deprived of the true pleasures of life as defined by the Quran. This is sustenance of the people who have self-declared respect honour in a society due to the possession of wealth and power (44:49). This the group of **Mutrafeen** (56:45). The group which lives on the hard work of fellow human beings' labor (37:66). Such sustenance may temporarily satisfy their desires, but will be of no use for the development of humanity as whole.

In (17:60) which is referred above, it is also possible that it means as quoted in (14:26). This may mean wrong ideology of life; however, these all are allegorical and used to illustrate a state of individuals and society.

Zikriya

زكريا

The Quran has mentioned **Zikriyah** as one of the messengers belonging to **Bani Israel** (6:85). He is referred in surah **Aal-e-Imran** (3:37-40), surah **Maryam** (19:2-15), and surah **Al-Ambia** (21:89-90). These verses mention that he was old and his wife could not conceive, but the capability to give birth to a child was restored in her (21:90) and **Yahya** was born as **Zikriyah's** son. He was the patron of **Maryam** (3:37).

Loqa's Bible says that during the reign of king Herodis of Yahudia, this was the name of an astrologer, and his wife was from among the descendants of **Haroon** and was named **Al-yashba**. They had no child as **Al-yashba** was infertile.

The Torah (Old Testament) mentions a messenger named **Zakariah**, a very big official of the Jews was called **Nabi** (prophet) which was translated as astrologer. But the Quran's concept of a **Nabi** is entirely different from this, and the Quran has counted **Zikriyah** as one a **Nabi (messenger receiving the revelation)**.

“زَكَاةَ الْمَالِ وَالزَّرْعِ” (*zaka al-maal az-zar'o*), “يَزْكُو” (*yazku*), “زُكُوًا” (*zukuwwa*), “أَزْكَى” (*azka*): for crops or animals to grow, to develop, to increase, to prosper.

“أَزْكَى اللَّهُ الْمَالَ وَزَكَاةً” (*azka allahu-lmala wazzakkahu*): Allah gave prosperity and multiplied wealth.

“زَكَ الرَّجُلُ يَزْكُو” (*zakar rajuluh yazku*): someone prospered and his abilities developed. His life became happier, rich and blossomed in all respects.. {*Taj-ul-Uroos* and *Ibn Qateebah, Al-qartain*. Vol. I page 62}

Therefore, the basic meanings of “زَك” (*zaka*) are to develop, prosper, grow and blossom in all respects.

Raghib has stated this verse to prefer this meaning:

18:19	...find out which is the best food and bring some that satisfy your appetite ...	فَلْيَنْظُرْ أَيُّهَا أَزْكَى طَعَامًا
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i.e. to select the food which has better overall nutritional value.

“الزَّكَاةُ” (*az-zakaat*) means to develop, to grow, to increase, to blossom {*T*}. It may also mean purity, probably in order to let the trees grow properly you have to pare the branches, etc, but this is not its basic meaning. In the Quran itself, in the same verse “أَزْكَى” (*azka*) and “أَطْهَرُ” (*at-har*) have been used separately in 2:232. Here “أَطْهَرُ” (*at-har*) is for purity and “أَزْكَى” (*azka*) for development. Purity is a negative virtue, i.e to stay away from impurities, but “زَكَاةُ” (*zakaat*) is a positive virtue, that is to blossom, to grow, to increase, to progress, to realize potentials, etc.

Muheet writes with reference to **Baizaai** that the meaning of “الزَّكَّى” (*azikki*) is to grow with a view to enhance all around abilities, one who develops his potentials from one stage of life to later part of life. There is an implicit element of self-development and continuous evolvement in this term.

“أَرْضٌ زَكِيَّةٌ” (*ardun zakiyyah*): lush green pasture which is very fertile and has abundant potential for growth.

“أَزْكَى” (*azka*) means very beneficial {M, F}.

“زَكَا” (*zaka*) means the figure which is a pair {M, F}.

Surah **Al-Kahaf** Allah commits to bestow them a son who will have better abilities than their previous son:

18:81	... better in character and conduct ...	خَيْرًا مِنْهُ زَكَاةً
18:74	..Individual with good character and conduct....	نَفْسًا زَكِيَّةً

At another place it is said:

19:19	... youth with good character and conduct..	عُلَمَاءَ زَكِيًّا
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In surah **Ash-Shams**, “زَكَّاهَا” (*zakkaha*) has been used against “دَسَّاهَا” (*dassaha*) (91:9-10).

“تَدْسِيَّةٌ” (*tadsiyatun*) means to suppress someone, to bury someone alive (16:59), or to curb human development. As such “تَزْكِيَّةٌ” (*tazkiah*) would mean to remove all restrictions and obstructions which may be hampering someone's progress and to facilitate path to self-development.

The Quran refers to the following term repeatedly in many places e.g. (2:83, 2:177):

	Establish Salah and provide Zakaah	أَقِمُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآتُوا الزَّكَاةَ
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Indeed these are the two basic pillars of the Quranic System which lay the foundations. For the detailed meaning of this term, see heading (Sd-L-W). You will find that its meaning is to establish a Quranic social order within the defined permanent values so that the individuals living within the society have the

option to attain the aim of defined and explained self-development. The question is what then is the purpose of establishing such a social order? The aim is to “إيتاي زكوة” (*eetayi zakat*) i.e. to provide self-development. In other words, to provide the opportunity and environment to the mankind with requisite means for their individual and collective growth and development. This development and growth include both aspects: the nurturing of man’s corporeal being and the development of his Self (personality).

In Sura *Al-Hajj*:

22:41	This is the group who when given power will establish the system of <i>salaah</i> and provide <i>zakaah</i>	الَّذِينَ إِنْ مَكَّنَّاهُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ أَقَامُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآتَوُا الزَّكَاةَ
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i.e. the basic responsibility of the Islamic State will be to provide *Zakaah* to others. The duty of an Islamic State would be to provide “الزَّكَاةَ” (*zakaah*). It will provide sustainable means of growth (both aspects as mentioned above) to all in their society and the mankind at large.

At another place *momins* are defined as:

23:4	Those who strive for <i>zakaah</i> (development and growth for the mankind).	هُمْ لِلزَّكَاةِ فَاعِلُونَ
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Now the question that comes to our mind is, how will the Islamic State fulfill this huge obligation? It is obvious that to fulfill this responsibility all means of production must remain with the state so that it can distribute sustenance according to people’s needs. Secondly, the individuals keep open (available) all that they earn above their needs, so that the state can take whatever and whenever it finds necessary for the provision of this collective responsibility. For this purpose, the Quran has not fixed any amount, all that is intended is to fulfill the need, so much so that it has been said that anything and all above one’s needs can be handed over to the state (2:219). Seen from this angle, the entire income of such a state is geared towards this mentioned prosperity, or fulfilling the needs of society’s individuals.

However, an Islamic \system can only be established gradually and in defined stages. Until the time that it shapes up completely, individuals will give, as in today’s governments, voluntary donations and income taxes will also be imposed. The Quran has used the term “صدقات” (*sadaqaat*) for them. Commonly we believe “صدقات” (*sadaqaat*) and “زكوة” (*zakat*) to have same meaning, so much that the avenues of spending of “صدقات” (*sadaqaat*) by the Quran (9:60) are also taken to be avenues for spending “زكوة” (*zakat*), but the Quran has used these terms in different contexts.

It is obvious from the discussion so far that these are not simply individualistic issues according to the Quran but these are the departments of the Islamic State. Whatever one gives individually to help a fellow human beings will be charity. In an Islamic State, ultimately there is no need of individual charity because it becomes the duty of the state to provide for every ones needs which includes both aspects of self-development. Whatever the Islamic State takes is not a state tax and “زكوة” (*zakat*) is not Allah’s tax as explained next.

This dualism of God and the sovereign is a product of Christianity, not of the Islam as revealed in the Quran. There is no place for this dualism whatsoever in Islam. In a state which is established for following Allah’s Laws, everything that is given to the Islamic State is given to Allah. For details see headings (*R-B-B*), (*N-F-Q*) and (*Sd-D-Q*).

In Surah *An-Najam* the Quran declares:

53:32	do not decide on your own that your Self (<i>Nafs</i>) has been purified, He knows who is righteous (as per the Quran).	فَلَا تُزَكُّوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ هُوَ أَعْلَمُ بِمَنِ اتَّقَى
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The criterion is explained in the Quran:

92:18	..he who gives his wealth for the development of others, has his Self-purified	الَّذِي يُؤْتِي مَا لَهُ يَنْزَغِي
92:5	he who gives and thus attains righteousness (<i>taqwa</i>)	مَنْ أَعْطَى وَاتَّقَى
92:7	..for him the path (of life) becomes easy...	فَسَيُسِّرُ لَهُ يَسْرَى

“الزَّلْفُ” (*az-zalaqu*), “الزُّلْفَى” (*zulfa*), “الزُّلْفَةُ” (*zulfah*): nearness, rank or grade.

“الزُّلْفَةُ” (*az-zulfah*): the part (long or short) of the initial or later night. The plural is “زُلُفٌ” (*zulaḥ*).

“الْمَزَالِفُ” (*al-mazalif*): steps, which take a man closer to his objective. This term has both connotations of nearness and stages or grades in the achievement of an objective. “دَرَجَةٌ” (*darajah*) also means steps which take a man upwards.

“زَلَفَ إِلَيْهِ” (*zalaḥa ilaih*): he came closer to him.

“أَزْلَفَهُ” (*azlafah*): brought him closer, gathered him.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to go forward in order to be closer.

Raghib says that “زُلُفٌ” (*zulaḥ*) means the stages of the night.

Kitabul Ashfaq says “الزُّلْفَةُ” (*az-zulfah*) means stages.

The Quran says:

67:27	At length, when they will see it close at hand..	فَلَمَّا رَأَوْهُ زُلْفَةً
34:37	..which brings you nearer to Us in stature...	تُقَرَّبُكُمْ عِنْدَنَا زُلْفَى
26:64	and We brought the others closer over there	وَأَزْلَفْنَا نَمَّ الْأَخْرِيْنَ
11:114	both ends of the day and some parts of the night	أَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ طَرَفِي النَّهَارِ وَزُلْفًا مِّنَ اللَّيْلِ

Also see heading (D-L-K) and (Th-R-F).

“زَلَقَ” (*zalaqa*), “زَلَقًا” (*zalaqa*), “زَلَقٌ” (*zalaq*), “يَزْلُقُ” (*yazluqu*), “يَزْلُقُ” (*yazlaq*), “زَلَقَ” (*zaliq*): to slip, to waver, to move from one’s place.

“الزَّلَقُ” (*az-zalaq*): smooth ground on which one may slip. Ground which has no vegetation and plants.

“الزَّلَقَةُ” (*az-zalqah*): smooth rock. can also be mirror {T, R, M}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:40	It can become a smooth and plain field which has no vegetation whatsoever (like a mirror)	فَتَصْبِحُ صَعِيدًا زَلَقًا
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“أَزْلَقَ فُلَانًا بَبَصَرِهِ” (*azlaqa fulanan bibasirih*): looked at him with sharp (angry) eyes, stared at him as if he will dislodge him from his place with his eyes {T, R, M}.

Surah *Al-Qalam* says about the non-believers:

68:51	they see you as if they will dislodge you from your place (deter you) with their very looks	لَيُزِلُّونَكَ بِأَبْصَارِهِمْ
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“زَلَّ” (*zal*), “زَلِيلٌ” (*zalil*), “مَزَلَّةٌ” (*mazillah*): to slip, to waver.

“الْمَزَلَّةُ” (*al-mazillatu*), “الْمَزَلَّةُ” (*al-mazallatuh*): the place on which one slips.

“أَزَلَّهُ” (*azallahu*): misguided him (2:36).

“أَزَلَّهُ” (*azallah*): slip, to move from one’s stance.

The Quran has used this word opposite “ثَبَّتَ” (*sabat*) in 16:94, which means stability, firm position based on principles.

Ibn Faris says any word in which there is a “ل” (*laam*) after “ز” (*ze*) has a connotation to move (from one’s place). In mutual conversation the term is used to waver, to change one’s opinion, or to make a judgemental error.

Raghib says “زَلَّ” (*zallah*) means a slip which is unintentional.

“زَلَّ” (*istazalla*): decide to persuade someone to move him away from his stance. (3:154).

“زَلِيلٌ” (*zalil*) also means to transfer from one place to another.

“قَوْسٌ زَلَّاءٌ” (*qausun zalla’u*): the bow, out of which the arrow shoots with high velocity.

“زَلَزَلَهُ” (*zalzalah*): means to move or shake something very fast, or move it from its location {*T*}.

“زَلَزَلَ” (*zalzal*), “يُزَلِّلُ” (*yuzalzil*), “زَلَزَلَتُ” (*zalzalatu*), “زَلَزَالًا” (*zilzala*): shook it {*T*}.

99:1	When the earth is shaken to its convulsion	إِذَا زُلْزِلَتِ الْأَرْضُ زِلْزَالَهَا
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Z-L-M ز ل م

“الزَّلْمُ” (*az-zalam*), “الزُّلْمُ” (*az-zulam*): the wooden part of the arrow which does not have feathers at its tail. Plural is “أَزْلَامٌ” (*azlaam*).

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be slim and smooth.

“أَزْلَامٌ” (*azlaam*) also means the arrows which the Arabs used in the period before Islam to carry out predictions or to foretell fate. Three arrows were used to be put into a bag. On one they used to write “إِفْعَلْ” (*if’al*) which means do, on the other “لَا تَفْعَلْ” (*la taf’al*), which means don’t, and the third one did not have any writing. When a man intended to do something, he used to come to the priest and asked him to find out whether he should carry out what he intended to do. Thereupon the priest, as per his practice, used to take out one arrow and tell him according to what was written on the arrow. If the arrow without writing was picked then they would pick again. Some people used to carry such arrows and used them when the need arose {*T, M*}. These arrows were also used for making draws and to divide the meat of the animals, in gambling (5:3). For draw see heading (*Q-L-M*).

The Quran stopped all these practices, because in this way individuals instead of deciding according to their intellect and understanding leave themselves at the mercy of pure chance. Such practices bring them down from the level of the stature of humanity and consign them to the world of pure chances. The Quran helps man to develop his intellect, insight and understanding and teaches him freedom. Thus it prevented him from all of this which stultifies his intellect and his freedom of choice. The Quran gives him full freedom (while remaining within the bounds of Allah’s laws) to exercise free will for deciding about his individual and collective affairs. However, without the guidance of the Quran the human condition has deteriorated to such extent that gambling has become common and is providing the basis of the capitalist system. Nations which are on the downfall not only give up their efforts but also leave the exercise of their intellect and reason and suffer the consequences as a result. A *momin* knows fully well that he is a living being, not a dead star. He does not depend on chances or coincidences, but acts within the permanent values and makes them subservient to his will.

Z-M-R ز م ر

“زَمْرٌ” (*zamar*): sound.

“الزَّمَارَةُ” (*aza zammaratu*), “الْمِزْمَارُ” (*al-mizmaar*): flute.

“زَمَرَ” (*zamara*), “يَزْمُرُ” (*yazmuru*), “يَزْمِرُ” (*yazmiru*), “زَمْرًا” (*zamra*): to play the flute.

“الزُمُرَةُ” (*az-zumrah*), the plural of which is “زُمُرٌ” (*zumar*), means scattered army or party, because all groups produce scattered sounds or noise {*T, M*}. This word is also used for gathering a group together by through blowing a bugle producing a high sound.

Raghib says it means a small party {*R*}.

The Quran says:

39:71	Those who reject the guidance will be led to hell in groups.	وَسِيقَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا إِلَىٰ جَهَنَّمَ زُمَرًا
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The word “زُمُرٌ” (*zumar*) seems to connote small groups {*Ribn Faris* says it has two basic meanings. One is the paucity of something and the second is sound.

Z-M-L

ز م ل

“الزَّمِيلُ” (*az-zameel*) is a man who sits atop a camel. It also means a companion who helps in arranging affairs before and during traveling.

“زَمَلَهُ” (*zamalahu*), “يَزِمِلُهُ” (*yazamiluhu*), “زَمَلًا” (*zamlā*): he made him ride behind him or made him sit on the (camel’s) howdah beside him.

“الزَّمْلُ” (*az-ziml*): load.

“إِزْدَمَلِ الْجَمْلُ” (*izdamalil himl*): he lifted the entire load in one go.

“الْمُزَامَلَةُ” (*al-muzaamalah*): for riders of the same weight to ride a camel on both sides or to load the same type of loads for balancing on a camel.

There are usually two riders on a camel. On longer journeys, people who sit together on a camel, are usually of similar weight, and also compatible to each other with similar outlook to life. The reason for this is that if their weights are quite different then the camel will feel uncomfortable due to unbalance. If they do not have a psychological harmony the journey will be very uncomfortable for both of them. The leader of a caravan should be the one who is sensible and capable of selecting compatible companions in the journey from all respects.

When the Quranic system was revealed to the Messenger (*pbuh*), the most important duty before him was to adopt “زَمِيلَانَهُ” (*zammeelana*), that is, to select companions who were psychologically in tune with the message, because such a great system’s success depended on selecting the right individuals. This was the duty towards which his attention was drawn by saying “يَا أَيُّهَا الْمُرْمِلُ” (*ya ayyohal muzammil*) in 73:1. Thereafter “تَزْمِيلُ” (*tazmeel*), i.e. the selection of companions, carried out by the Messenger (*pbuh*) is unmatched in human history till now.

“إِزْدَمَلْ” (*izdamal*), “تَزَمَّلْ” (*tazammal*), “أَزَمَلَ فِي ثِيَابِهِ” (*az-zammala fi siyaabehe*) also means that he got himself wrapped in his clothes. Hence “الْمُزَمِّلُ” (*al-muzammil*) could also mean someone who is careless in his affairs and is slack in his work {*R*}. Obviously in “يَا أَيُّهَا الْمُرْمِلُ” (*ya ayyohal muzammil*), this meaning cannot be taken although it is a matter of surprise that a high caliber linguist like **Raghib** has said that it this term is used allegorically and means, who are careless in their affairs and slack in their work {*R*}.

Ibn Faris has written that this root basically means one who bears the load. He also mentioned that “الزَّمِيلُ” (*az-zumayl*) could be a person who when faced with difficulties wraps himself tightly in his clothes and becomes like a ‘bundle’ of clothes.

“الْمُزَامَلَةُ” (*al-muzaamala*) means to load a camel with equal weights on both sides. This way, “الْمُزَمِّلُ” (*al-muzammil*) would mean one who is very careful and is keen in carrying out this task. “تَزْمِيلُ” (*tazmeel*). “الزَّمْلُ” (*az-zaml*) also means load and “إِزْدَمَلِ الْجَمْلُ” (*izdamalil himal*) means that he loaded the entire load at once {*T*}. From this aspect “مُزَمِّلٌ” (*muzammil*) would be he who accepts and bears the responsibility which is incumbent in following the Message.

Kashaf says with reference to **Akramah**, that “يَا أَيُّهَا الْمُزَمِّلُ” (*ya ayyohal muzammil*) means “O you who bears a great burden of responsibility”

Tafseer Rooh Al-mu'aani says it means the bearer of the burden of the Message and its responsibilities. **Tafseer Khazin** also supports this. **Tastari** says in his book that “الْمُزَمِّلُ” (*al-muzammil*) is one who has adopted the attributes of Allah (this defines the highest scale in forming companionship with Allah to establish the Islamic System with a view to solve human problems).

Tafseer Fatahul Qadeer (Shokaani) says it means “مُزَمِّلٌ بِالْقُرْآنِ” (*muzammilu bil Quran*) i.e. one who takes on himself the responsibilities defined within the Quran. One who takes all guidance from the Quran.

Qurtabi has also supported these meanings and has attributed his interpretation to **Abbas (RAH)**. To conclude, when the Messenger (*pbuh*) was called “يَا أَيُّهَا الْمُزَمِّلُ” (*ya ayyohal muzammil*), it was a reference to his great responsibilities as a messenger, the purpose of which was to bring a great revolution for the good of mankind with the willing assistance of a group of *momineen*.

Some think that “مُزَمِّلٌ” (*muzammil*) is a word which has originated from “مُتَزَمِّلٌ” (*mutazammil*).

Z-M-He-R

ز م ه ر

“الزَّمْهَرِيرُ” (*az-zamharir*): intense cold. It also means the moon {*T, M*}.

“إِزْمَهَرَّ الْيَوْمُ” (*iz meharral yaum*): the day became very cold.

“إِزْمَهَرَّتِ الْوَجْهَ” (*iz maharral wajah*): the face was badly distorted and the teeth were visible.

The Quran says about *jannah*:

76:13	there will not be intense cold or intense heat	لَا يَرَوْنَ فِيهَا شَمْسًا وَلَا زَمَهَرِيرًا
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“الْمُزْمَهِّرُ” (*al-muz mahirru*) means a man with ‘smiling’ teeth {*T, M*}. This is probably taken from the chattering of teeth in intense cold.

Ibn Faris says it is possible that this word is based upon “زَهْرٌ” (*zahr*) with an additional “م” (*meem*).

“زَهْرٌ” (*zahr*) means to sparkle, shine.

“إِزْمَهَرَّتِ الْكَوَاكِبُ” (*izmaharratil kawakib*): the stars sparkled. When it is winter or cold weather, stars appear to sparkle brighter.

Zanjabeel

زنجبيل

“الزَّنْجَبِيلُ” (*az-zanjabeel*): ginger. The Arabs used the term to define something which possess very fragrant smell {*T*}.

Muheet thinks that it was originally a Persian word “*shankabeel*” which got adopted in Arabic.

The Quran says:

76:17	it will be a mixture of ginger	كَانَ مِزَاجُهَا زَنْجَبِيلًا
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For details, see heading (M-Z-J).

Z-N-M

ز ن م

Ibn Faris says “زَنَمَ” (*zanam*) basically means to hang a thing onto another, to latch onto another thing.

“الزَّانِمُ” (*az-zaneem*): a man who does not belong ancestrally to a tribe but is attached to the tribe {*T*}.

“زَنْمَتَا الْعَنْزِ” (*zanata-lghuz*): a phrase which referred to two tit like things hanging from a goat’s neck.

Ancestral lineage had great importance within the Arabs. This obviously had a consequence for a man who was not from a tribe i.e no descendant lineage or of unknown lineage but was living within a tribe, was consigned to a demeaning position.

From this “الزَّانِمُ” (*az-zaneem*) was referred to an individual who was known for being mean and wicked {*T*}.

“الزُّنْمَةُ” (*az-zunmah*): a tree which has no leaves {*T*}. The Quran has used the term “زَنِيمٌ” (*zaneem*) in 68:13.

“زَنَى” (zana), “يَزْنِي” (yazni), “زِنْيَانٍ” (ziniyan), “زِنَاءٌ” (zina): fornication {T, R}. It means to have sexual intercourse without marriage.

17:32	do not go near <i>zina</i>	وَلَا تَقْرُبُوا الزَّانِيَةَ
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This means, not only stay from from *zina*, but do not even approach anything that has anything to do with *zina*.

Surah *Al-Furqaan* says:

25:18	do not commit <i>zina</i>	وَلَا يَزْنُونَ
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“الزَّانِي” (az-zaani): a man who commits *zina*, “الزَّانِيَةُ” (az-zaniyah): a woman who commits *zina*. Each of them are to be lashed a hundred times as a punishment (24:2) within an Islamic State, as an exception if a married who was a slave in the past, (according to the customs prevalent in the pre-Islamic era) then the punishment is halved (4:25). This is because it is possible that a slave girl who has been brought up in an environment of low morality, may not show same level of character and conduct as a girl of good and strong upbringing. This serves as an indicator that how profoundly the Quran views moral conduct of human beings and takes into account the environmental factors which shape human personality and thus makes appropriate allowances. It must be noted that the Quran eliminated the institution of slavery once for all. Details can be found under the heading (M-L-K).

This should be noted that the punishment of stoning to death (or *rajm*) is not stated anywhere in the Quran.

This aspect has been done extensively researched in our times as to what effects sexual affairs have on the rise and fall of nations and to what extent the nations which do not respect the celibacy (before marriage) of its people descend low in character socially and morally. Anyone having an interest in this subject can refer to the book titled “*Letters to Saleem vol. III*”.

“زَهَدٌ” (zahad), “يَزْهَدُ” (yazhad), “زُهْدًا” (zuhda): not to have a liking to something, turn away in dislike {T}, to avoid something, or to keep a distance {T}. The verb is “زَهَدٌ” (zahid).

In Surah *Yusuf* it is stated that the caravan people disposed off Yusuf at a small price because:

22:20	they did not have much interest in <i>Yusuf</i>	وَكَانُوا فِيهِ مِنَ الرَّهْبَانِ
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“الزَّهِيدُ” (az-zaheed): little and insignificant {T}.

“الزَّاهِدُ” (az-zaahidu), “الزَّاهِدُ” (az-zaheed): impolite man, someone with ill manners, or someone who eats little {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means the paucity of something, Something in short supply.

Muheet says that “زَهَدٌ” (zuhd) means to stop taking interest in something. Cease liking something.

The term “زَهَدٌ” (zuhd) or “زَاهِدٌ” (zahid) commonly used in the Indian Sub continent in relation to e.g. mysticism or sufism does not appear anywhere in the Quran. This is a term of *tasawwuf* (mysticism) in which giving up necessities and responsibilities of this world has great significance. This concept is against the Quranic teachings. *Tasawwuf* itself is an alien as far as the Quranic teachings are concerned. According to the Quran, a believer has a responsibility to bring natural forces under human control for the

benefit of the mankind as a whole and enjoy the pleasures of this life within the values defined and explained in the Quranic. The Quran pronounces in no uncertain terms to challenge those who declare the bounties of this world which Allah has created for the benefit of mankind as forbidden (7:42). A **momin** only avoids those things which Allah has specifically forbidden otherwise he brings all other things of this world into use and benefits from them.

Z-He-R ز ه ر

“الزَّيْبَةُ” (*az-zahrah*), “الزَّيْرَةُ” (*az-zaharah*): plant, or flower. Some say it is a flower in blossom.
 “الزَّيْبَةُ مِنَ الدُّنْيَا” (*az-zahratur minad duniya*): the scenic views e.g. greenery, water, hills, etc in the world.
 Beauty and splendour, the means of adornment (20:131).
 “الزُّهْرَةُ” (*az-zuhrah*): whiteness {T}, beauty, brightness.
 “الزَّهْرِيَّاتُ مِنَ الْآيَامِ” (*az-zahriyyaat minal ayyam*): the spring season {M}.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meanings of this word are beauty, light, and cleanliness.

Z-He-Q ز ه ق

Muheet says “زُبُوْقٌ” (*zuhuq*) means to come out/exit with difficulty.
 “زَبَقَتِ النَّفْسُ” (*zahaqatin nafs*): he died with difficulty (that is he breathed his last with difficulty).
 “الزَّاهِقُ” (*az-zahiq*): plump animal, also an animal which is very weak. The word can have opposing meanings.
 “الزُّبُوْقُ” (*az-zahuq*): means deep well and also used for the path between two lofty mountains {T}.
 Whether with difficulty or ease, it means for something to exit {T}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to move forward, to pass away, or to surpass.

“زَبَقَتِ الرَّاحِلَةُ زُبُوْقًا” (*zahaqatir rahilatan zahuqa*): the she camel overtook the horses.
 “زَبَقَ السَّيْمُ زُبُوْقًا” (*zahaqas sahmuhu zahuqa*): the arrow went past the target.
 “زَبَقَتِ نَفْسُهُ” (*zahaqat nafsuh*): he died {T}.
 “تَزَبَقُوا أَنْفُسَهُمْ” (*tazhaqu anfusahim*): they died (9:55).
 “الزَّاهِقُ” (*az-zahiqu*): a defeated man {T}.
 “الْمُرْبِقُ” (*al-murhaqu*): the murdered one.
 “زَبَقَ الشَّيْءُ” (*zahaqas shaiyi*): something was destroyed, or was ineffective {T}.

The Quran says about falsehood (*batil*):

21:18	every concept that is against the truth (<i>haqq</i>), creates destructive results and remains unsuccessful (gets defeated)	فَإِذَا هُورَاقٌ
17:81	and say that truth (<i>haqq</i>) has arrived and falsehood (<i>batil</i>) is banished. In reality falsehood (by nature) is bound to parish.	وَقُلْ جَاءَ الْحَقُّ وَزَهَقَ الْبَاطِلُ - إِنَّ الْبَاطِلَ كَانَ زَهُوقًا

In fact, **batil** is destined to be banished. Here “زُبُوْقٌ” (*zahuq*) means the same as “زَاهِقٌ” (*zahiq*) but with some exaggeration. **Batil** stays only till **haqq** (Allah’s constructive program) does not arrive. Once it comes, **batil** gets defeated and wiped out. It does not have the ability to stay in when confronted by **haqq**. For more details see headings (H-Q-Q) and (B-Te-L).

“أَزْبَقْتُ الْإِنَاءَ” (*azhaqatul inaa*): I turned the pot over {T}.

Raghib says “زَبَقَتِ نَفْسُهُ” (*zahaqat nafsuhu*) means he died due to sorrow and grief {R}.

“زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*): Two things which are compatible with each other e.g. a pair of shoes. “زَوْجَانِ” (*zaujaan*): Or two things which are opposing each other e.g. day and night. In both cases, each one of them is called the other’s “زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*).

“زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*) actually means someone who makes a combination or pairs with someone else, either in similarity or opposite.

“زَوَّجَ الشَّيْءَ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*zaujash shaiya bish shaiyi*): he paired a thing with something like similar to it.

“وَإِذَا النُّفُوسُ زُوِّجَتْ” (*wa izan nafusu zuwwijat*): when every person will meet his companions and counterparts (81:7).

44:54	they will be made companions with <i>Hoor’een</i> (<i>Companions with high intellect</i>)	زَوْجَانَهُمْ يَخُورُ عَيْنَ
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For the meaning of “حُورٌ” (*hoor*) see heading (H-W-R).

Lane says that everything of a homogenous variety is called “أَزْوَاجٌ” (*azwaaaj*).

37:22	gather the oppressive parties and their ilk	أُحْشِرُوا الَّذِينَ ظَلَمُوا وَأَزْوَاجَهُمْ
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With regards to the dwellers of *jannnat*, it is declared:

4:57	Therein shall be <i>azwaaaj</i> with pristine intellect for you	لَهُمْ فِيهَا أَزْوَاجٌ مُطَهَّرَةٌ
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Here it does not only mean virtuous wives or husbands, but also companions with the same pure thoughts. In a heavenly society (*jannah*), there is existence of virtuous thoughts. Note that this heavenly society will be formed in this world. Here the relationship between husband and wife will include the responsibility of progeny as well. But such a concept of man and woman is not found in the Quran and the companionship in the hereafter will not be for progeny. This will be based on companionship; however, we cannot understand the nature of this at our present level of understanding and existence. The Quran has explained the hereafter concepts allegorically.

Because of these meanings, the species of everything is called *zauj* {*Lane*}.

“أَزْوَاجًا مِنْهُمْ” (*azwaaaja minhum*): people who are of different kind but of the same species, or things of many kind but of the same type (20:131).

26:7	We created different things of a good quality	كَمْ أَنْبَأْنَا فِيهَا مِنْ كُلِّ زَوْجٍ كَرِيمٍ
38:58	similar types of various punishments	وَأَخْرَجْنَا مِنْ شَكْلِهِ أَزْوَاجًا
51:49	We have created things which are <i>zauj</i> to one another, either similar or opposite	وَمِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ خَلَقْنَا زَوْجَيْنِ

For example the sky is the *zauj* of the earth. They together make a pair or a combination. Winter is the *zauj* of summer, and a shoe is the *zauj* of the other shoe. *Zauj* also means whose companion is unique. This word can be used for either one of them; however, for the combination, we will use “زَوْجَانِ” (*zaujaan*) {*Lane*}.

“إِزْدَوَّجَ” (*izdawaj*), “تَزَاوَّجَ” (*tazawaj*): to make two parts go together; or words that rhyme; or for two problems to be related to each other.

“زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*) with plural “أَزْوَاجٌ” (*azwaaaj*) means companion or friend {*Lane*}. It also means either husband or wife. The husband is the “زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*) of his wife and she is the “زَوْجٌ” (*zauj*) of her husband {*T, M*}. One complements the other. This is married (conjugal) life. The Quran has termed them each other’s covering like a dress which covers the body. See heading (L-B-S). In verse 13:38, “أَزْوَاجًا” (*azwaaaja*) means wives.

“تَزَوَّجْتُ امْرَأَةً” (*tazawajtu imra’ah*): I married a woman.

As per the Quran, it will suffice to say that the term “تَزَوَّجَهُ النَّوْمُ” (*tazawwajahun naum*) is used allegorically when one is in a blissful sleep {*T, M*}. The relationship of a married couple is like a blissful sleep which is a source of pleasure to both partners. See heading (N-K-H). The wives and husbands in a heavenly society on earth will also be pure of heart and soul and good companions in the journey of life extending beyond death to the next life. The Quran has described their characteristics in different chapters. As far as the heaven in the next life is concerned, as mentioned earlier and in detail under the heading (J-N-N) that we cannot comprehend it at our present level of understanding. Hence, we are unable to say what the condition will be there. We cannot deny the fact that a companionship based on similar values and interests is blissful in this life as the Quran has stated in (2:221).

Z-W-D

ز و د

“الزَّادُ” (*az-zaad*): something more than the present needs and which is saved for later time. {*R*}. It means food (provision), whether for the present or future, especially the food which is prepared for a journey {*F*}.

“الْمِزْوَدُ” (*al-mizwaad*): tiffin carrier {*T*}.

“زَوَّدْتُهُ تَزْوِيدًا” (*zawwattuhu tazweeda*): I gave him food for the journey.

“تَزَوَّدَ” (*tazawwad*): he took food along for the journey {*T*}.

The Quran says in respect of *Hajj*:

2:197	Take a provision for the journey,, so you may not be dependent upon others???	وَتَزَوَّدُوا فَإِنَّ خَيْرَ الزَّادِ التَّقْوَىٰ
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Ibn Faris says with reference to *Khalil*, that “تَزَوَّدَ” (*tazawwad*) means to take something good from one place to another.

Z-W-R

ز و ر

“الزَّوْرُ” (*az-zaur*): the upper part of the chest where the bones confluence. It is also used for a visitor.

“زُرْتُهُ” (*zartuhu*): I bared my chest before him (confronted him).

“الزَّوْرُ” (*az-zaur*) and “الزِّيَارَةُ” (*az-ziyarah*), “الْمَزَارُ” (*al-mazaar*): to meet, to visit.

“الزَّوْرُ” (*az-zaur*) also means the bent chest which leans on one side.

“الْأَزْوَرُ” (*al-azwar*): one who has a chest which is crooked or bent. One who leans his chest to one side more than the other while walking. One who looks from side of his eyes. The word means to lean to one side, as well as to move away from the right direction.

Ibn Faris says it means to lean to one side, as well as to move to onside.

It says in Surah *Al-Kahaf*:

18:17	the sun moves towards one side of their cave (i.e. does not shine directly into their cave)	تَزَاوَرُ عَنْ كَهْفِهِمْ
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“زَوَّرَ عَنْهُ” (*zawwar unhu*): he shifted or moved away from it.

“الزُّورُ” (*az-zuur*) means to tell a lie.

“حَبْلٌ لَهُ زُورٌ” (*hablun lahu zuur*): a rope with twisted fibres or threads {*T, M, R*}.

Surah *Al-Hajj* says:

22:30	Avoid talk based on lies (traditional translation)	وَأَجْتَنِبُوا قَوْلَ الزُّورِ
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The above verse actually means to avoid any act or deed which is not in line with the defined righteous path. Every thought and action one takes away from the righteous path “صراط مستقيم” (*sirat-e-mustaqeem*), would fall under “زُرْ” (*zuur*). Islam is a Movement, which has a definite aim. Therefore, there is no room for “زُرْ” (*zuur*) in it. The next verse elaborates this:

22:31	turn away from all other paths and move towards the path defined by Allah (i.e the Quran)	خُتَفَاءَ اللَّهِ
22:31	do not mix it with an outside thought, emotion, and preference	غَيْرَ مُشْرِكِينَ بِهِ

This has also stated in Ssurah *Al-Furqan*:

25:4	An injustice and a lie	ظُلْمًا وَزُورًا
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“كَلَامٌ مُزَوَّرٌ” (*kalamun muzawwar*): fabricated talk and a pack of lies.

“زَوَّرَ الشَّيْءَ” (*zawwarsh shaiyi*): to mix and garnish a matter with lies.

“تَزْوِيرٌ” (*tazweer*) means to remove “زُرْ” (*zuur*). Therefore it means to rehabilitate.

Ibnul Airabi says that “تَزْوِيرٌ” (*tazweer*) would be used when something is improved, whether it is good or bad {T}.

It also means to meet or to be confronted. It is used in 102:2:

102:2	until you reach your graves	حَتَّىٰ تَزُومَ الْمَقَابِرَ
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Z-W-L ز و ل

“زَالَ” (*zaal*), “يَزُولُ” (*yazulu*), “يَزَالُ” (*yazaal*), “زَوَالًا” (*zawala*): for something to be lost, to change, to be depressed, to move to one side, to be removed, to go afar, to be parted, to desist.

The Quran has used this word opposite to “أَمْسَكَ” (*amsaka*) in 35:31, which means to prevent.

35:41	Verily Allah’s law is holding the sky and the earth so that they do not move from their places (do not leave their celestial places)	إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُمْسِكُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ أَنْ تَزُولَا
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“زَيْلٌ” (*zayyal*): to separate {T, M, R}

2:217	they will always be like this	لَا يَزَالُونَ
10:28	We will separate them	فَنَزَّلْنَا بَيْنَهُمْ
48:25	if they had separated	لَوْ تَزَيَّلُوا

Raghib says “زَوَالٌ” (*zawaal*) refers to the movement of something which is initially stable and later becomes unstable.

Z-Y-T ز ي ت

“زَيْتٌ” (*zait*): olive oil (24:35).

“زَيْتُونَةٌ” (*zaitoonah*): an olive tree, or its fruit (24:35, 80:29) {R}. It is considered to be a very useful and beneficial plant {M}.

The Quran says:

95:103	By <i>At-teen</i> and the <i>Az-zaitoon</i> and the <i>At-toor</i>	وَالزَّيْتُونِ وَالْأَنْثُونِ وَطُورٍ
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Here “الزَّيْتُونُ” (*az-zaitoon*) means a mount named “زيتا” (*zita*) in Palestine. *Lataif-ul-Lugha* has mentioned it as *Jabalash sham*. *Isa* or Jesus was born there, and “الْأَنْثُونُ” (*at-teen*) is the place where *Noah* received his Message. The Quran has said that messages towards *Noah's*, *Isa*, *Moosa* and *Muhammed (pbuh)* are from Allah. These are the divine invitations towards the establishment of Allah's social order and to educate mankind about the ultimate truth.

95:4-6	Indeed We created the Man...	لَعَدَّخَلْقَنَا الْإِنْسَانَ
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Z-Y-D

ز ي د

“زَيْدٌ” (*zaid*) means to develop, be nurtured, to grow and blossom, to increase, to flourish..
 “زَادَ اللَّهُ خَيْرًا” (*zadallahu khaira*), “زَيْدٌ” (*zayyadahu*) means to give more or to increase {T}.
 “إِزْدَادٌ” (*izdada*), “إِزْدِيَادٌ” (*izdiyada*): to grow more, or to produce more {M}.

Surah *Ar-Raad* has used “إِزْدِيَادٌ” (*izdiyaad*) opposite to “غَيْضٌ” (*ghaiz*) in 13:8, which means to decrease, or go inside, or to be absorbed.

Surah *Yunus* has used the word “زِيَادَةٌ” (*ziyadatun*) in 10:26, while “مَزِيدٌ” (*mazeed*) has been used in 50:35, which means the addition that is made after something has been completed.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:89	grow more (increase) in denial.	ثُمَّ إِذَا دُؤِ اكْفَرًا
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Surah *Al-Ahzaab* has mentioned *Zaid* in 33:37. This is the only companion of the Messenger (*pbuh*) who has been mentioned in the Quran. He was the son of *Harasa* and the Messenger's beloved servant and adopted son. He was married to the Messenger's cousin *Zainab*.

For the meaning of “الزَّادُ” (*az-zaad*), see heading (Z-W-D).

Z-Y-Gh

ز ي غ

“زَاغٌ” (*zaagh*), “يَزِيعُ” (*yazeegh*), “زَايِغٌ” (*zaigha*): to lean to one side.
 “زَاغَبَ الشَّمْسُ” (*zaaghatish shams*): the sun commenced setting {T}.

Raghib says that although “زَالَ” (*zaal*), “مَالَ” (*maala*), and “زَاغٌ” (*zaagha*) express almost the same meaning, but “زَاغٌ” (*zaagh*) means to move away from the right path towards the wrong direction {T}.

Muheet with reference to the procedure has explained that wherever the Quran has used the word “زَيْغٌ” (*zaigh*), it means to lean to one side, except when it says “زَاغَتِ الْأَبْصَارُ” (*zaaghatil absaar*) which means the eyes to be opened wide, or to remain open (in amazement) {M}.

The Quran says:

61:56	When they diverted from Allah's guidance, the law of Requital made them lean towards that very path.	فَلَمَّا زَاغُوا أَزَاغَ اللَّهُ قُلُوبَهُمْ
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This verse reveals a great truth. Generally it is said that guidance or going astray is controlled by God (is in His hands). He can guide whoever He wishes and lead astray, whomever He wishes. He seals the hearts of those who are to be led astray etc. This concept is completely against the teachings of the Quran and the Law of Requit. The Quran declares that man is created with the freedom to act as he chooses, he decides for himself whether to go on the right path or otherwise. The type of decision makes him subject to the corresponding laws. If he takes the wrong path then all his abilities get utilized in traversing the wrong path and are wasted.

51:8	only he who wants to turn away from the right path gets turned away	يُؤْفِكُ عَنْهُ مَنْ أَفَكَ
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It is not Allah's Will to coerce someone to adopt the right path if he wants to take the wrong path, or if a man wants to stay on the right path then he is not turned away from it. Only those who wish to follow the crooked ways have their hearts turned away from the truth. By virtue of possessing a free will the initiative is in man's own hands. Allah's laws help a person according to his own choice and decision to act – freedom to choose is at the heart of human functioning and with this comes the responsibility. For example, it is Allah's law that if we close your eyes, it will become dark for us, but if we open our eyes, we will be able to see in the light.

In Surah *An-Najam* with reference to the Messenger (*pbuh*):

53:17	your sight has neither moved away from the truth nor has it crossed the limit.	مَا زَاغَ الْبَصَرُ وَمَا طَغَى
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Here “مَاطَغَى” (*ma tagha*) has made it clear that although a messenger's knowledge of the revelation is far greater than any other human being, it is still limited in comparison to Allah. It can't cross the limits set for it by Allah.

In Surah *Saba*:

34:12	...if any of them turned away from our command order..	وَمَنْ يَرِغْ مِنْهُمْ عَنْ أَمْرِنَا
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“زَاغَتِ الْأَبْصَارُ” (*zaaghatil ansaar*) has been used at the times of chaos during a collective punishment (33:10). It either means that at times of fear, one's eyes do not stay at one point, or as *Muheet* says, it means that the eyes remain lifted (out of fear or bewilderment). In any case, the purpose is to describe a state of fear.

“زَيْغٌ” (*zaigh*) has been used to describe the change in one's opinion towards someone (38:63). Its meaning is given as being crooked, and lean towards falsehood (3:9). That is, instead of concentrating and be stolid on a point described by the Quran, move away hither or thither, to turn somewhere else, to follow one's wishes, desires and wishes. This is a very risky attitude; the right path is that which is defined by the Quran, irrespective of what what our hearts and minds wish.. What the Quran says is the truth, not what our leanings are. Anyone who goes to the Quran with preconceived ideas and with the intention of getting support for those ideas, can never find the right guidance.

To get the right guidance from the Quran, the mind must be free from all the preconceptions and preconceived beliefs. This is the reason that the Quran has described “زَيْغٌ” (*zaigh*) as the opposite of guidance (3:7). For more details see heading (H-K-M).

Z-Y-L

ز ي ل

See heading (Z-W-L).

Z-Y-N

ز ي ن

“الزَّيْنَةُ” (*az-zeenah*): the thing which is used to adorn something. Some say that something to be perceived by someone as beautiful is also called “زَيْنَةٌ” (*zeenah*).

“زَيَّنَ” (*zayyan*): to adorn something, to make something appear more beautiful, this also covers flattery {T}.

Iblees declared:

15:39	I'll make the earthly life appear so attractive (to men that they will decide to make it their destiny) (the concept of life will be materialistic)	لَا زَيْنَ لَهُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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“إِزَّيَّنَ” (*iz-zayyan*): to be adorned or beautified (10:4).

20:60	the day of adornment	يَوْمَ الزَّيْنَمِ
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Then about **Bani Israel** the Quran quotes:

20:87	those things with which people of the community used to adorn themselves	أَوَزَّارِمِنْ زِينَمِ الْقَوْمِ
7:148	their jewelry	حُلِيِّمِ

The Quran not only takes into account the utilitarian aspect of utilities but also considers the aesthetic aspects. That is why it not only allows us to add beauty to ourselves and to our environment but goes a step further by directing us to do so.

7:31	Adopt beauty and adornment while following Our laws	خُذُوا زِينَتَكُمْ عِنْدَ كُلِّ مَسْجِدٍ
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The Quran declares: by saying:

7:32	Say: who has forbidden the beautiful bounties of Allah which He has produced for His servants?	قُلْ مَنْ حَرَّمَ زِينَةَ اللَّهِ الَّتِي أَخْرَجَ لِعِبَادِهِ
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This is for all to use:

18:7	That which is on earth We have made it attractive and beautiful	إِنَّا جَعَلْنَا مَا عَلَى الْأَرْضِ زِينَةً لِّهَا
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Nothing is forbidden on this earth; however, it must be borne in mind that the pursuit of these things should not become the sole purpose of life (18:46). These should be used for helping in achieving the real purpose of life. In short, there is no harm in enjoying the adornments of life, but whenever there is clash with the laws mentioned in the Quran, those adornments and attractions should be sacrificed for upholding the Quranic values. This is the crux of the Quranic teachings and the main aim of Islamic System(**Deen**).

For example The Quran has directed (in the context of veil) that when men and women go about outside they should lower their gaze and guard their modesty (24:30-31) and the women should:

24:31	Not display their beauty and ornaments except of which appears naturally	لَا يُبْدِينَ زِينَتَهُنَّ إِلَّا مَا ظَهَرَ مِنْهَا
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Here adornments mean things which women use for beautification, for instance jewelry etc. This seems to be supported by the next part of the same verse where it is said:

24:31	they should not step hard on the ground so whatever they are hiding among their adornments is made obvious	وَلَا يَضْرِبْنَ بِأَرْجُلِهِنَّ لِيُعْلَمَ مَا يُخْفِينَ مِنْ زِينَتِهِنَّ
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By stepping hard on the ground, the jewelry like anklets make a sound and draw attention, as far as the adornment of the upper part of the body is concerned, it is advised that they should cover their body with

shawls (24:31) or put on “جلباب” (*jalbaab*) (33:59) which is the same sort of cloth as a longer and wider overall. This means that they should not exhibit the things of their adornment, although if it is done in front of men in their household then there is no harm (24:31).

Sexual attraction and urge are not like the pangs of hunger which arouses at its own as and when body needs it. This emotion is aroused on instigation and by thinking about it. The Quran directs us to stop those causes which lead to provoking such thoughts and consequently cause arousing this urges. One of the biggest instigations is by women to exhibit their adornment and provocative turn out in front of other men, and this what is forbidden by the Quran.

This letter appears in the beginning of “حرف مضارع” (*harf muzaarih*) which is such a verb that contains connotations of both future and present tense. But when it appears at the beginning of a word, the sentence is considered to only be about future. As for example “سَيَفْعَلُ” (*sayaf'al*) means that he will work.

It normally means near future tense, but near or distant future does not matter. Some say that it can also hold the meaning of infinity.

2:142	These misguided will continue to say that...	سَيَقُولُ السُّفَهَاءُ
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Some even say that when it appears with some verb which refers to some promise or commitment, then it holds the meaning of stressing on an issue.

2:137	Allah will surely be sufficient for you against them	فَسَيَكْفِيكَهُمُ اللَّهُ
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S-A-L س أ ل

“سَأَلْتُهُ الشَّيْءَ” (*saaltuhush shaiya*): I asked him for a thing.

“سَأَلْتُهُ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ وَبِهِ” (*sa altuhu unish shaiyi wabehi*): I enquired from him about something.

“أَسْأَلُهُ” (*asalah*), “سُئِلَ” (*sulah*): met the need in question.

“السَّائِلُ” (*as-sa'il*): one who requests for something, needy {T}.

“الْمَسْأَلَةُ” (*al-masa latah*): need, necessity {M}.

The Quran declares:

93:10	Do not scold the needy (thinking him to be lowly)	أَمَّا السَّائِلَ فَلَا تَنْهَرْ
55:29	Everything in the universe is asking God to fulfil its needs. (everything is dependent on his system of sustenance for its development)	يَسْأَلُهُ مَنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ

In Surah *As-sajdah* in reference to land and its produce:

41:10	it should be kept open (or available) for all needy	سَوَاءٌ لِلسَّائِلِينَ
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Since land is the main source of human sustenance, it should be freely available to all. This is the purpose of the creation of the earth. It is not the purpose that some should put barriers around the land and consider this to be their personal property. Allah has provided everything which is necessary for the sustenance of the human life.

14:34	And he provided for you everything you had asked for	وَأَنْتُمْ مِنْ كُلِّ مَا سَأَلْتُمُوهُ
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This is part of His system of sustenance, and to consider it as means of nourishment for a particular class as a private property is a heinous crime.

It is also used as asking one another about some matter of mutual interest as used in surah *An-Naba*:

78:1	About what are they asking one another?	عَمَّ يَتَسَاءَلُونَ
37:24	who are questioned	مَسْئُولُونَ
20:36	Verily you are granted your request, <i>Moosa</i>	قَدْ أُوتِيتَ سُؤْلَكَ يٰمُوسَى

Here “سُؤْل” (*suul*) means request, need, demand, or your demanded thing.

“سؤال” (*sawaal*) or question basically means need or some necessity. When we question somebody, we are indeed demanding for some kind of an answer. The Quran has to be viewed carefully to determine the context in which it is used e.g. whether it means to demand or to question.

س أ م S-A-M

“سَئِم” (*saim*), “يَسْأَم” (*yasaam*): to become tired of something.

“أَسْأَمَهُ” (*asaama*): he tired me out; he bored me {T}.

Some say that “سَأَم” (*saam*) also means laziness {M}.

41:49	man does not get tired of desiring for wealth	لَا يَسْتَمُ الْإِنْسَانُ مِنْ دُعَاءِ الْخَيْرِ
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This verse means that his demand is not just for fulfilling his needs but for becoming better than others, and thus his desires have no limits.

102:2	... till he meets his death	حَتَّىٰ زُرْتُمُ الْمَقَابِرَ
2:282	do not be tardy in writing down a loan agreement (do not be frustrated or tired of it).	وَلَا تَسْمُمُوا أَنْ تُكْتَبَوهُ

سبأ Saba

It was the name of the capitol city of a state which in the times of *Suleman* was ruled by a queen. The Quran has referred to this nation, its state and about its queen (34:15, 27:22). The fertility of the land has been specifically referred and then its subsequent destruction by floods. The people were creative and had built a very big dam for irrigating their lands and subsequently the flooding took place because the dam was damaged due to lack of maintenance.

In 1955, an American archaeologist had discovered some ruins in southern Arabia, especially in the Yemen area. The name of his book is “Qataban and Sheba” and the author is Wendell Phillips. The ruins throw light on the tale told by the Quran, especially the dam and the destruction by floods because of damage to the dam (34:19).

“السَّبَاءُ” (*as-saba*) means one who is in the liquor business, and “سَبَا الْخَمْرُ” (*saba al-khamr*) means that he bought liquor {T, M}. If the city was named with reference to this, then the mind goes towards the Taakistan which were abundant there. But “السُّبَّاءُ” (*subah*) also means long journey {T, M}, and perhaps this capitol city was named with this reference.

The Quran says refers to the desire of the people as referred in this prayer:

34:19	Our Sustainer, prolong our journey so that our trade increases	رَبَّنَا بَعْدَ بَيِّنَاتِنَا
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About queen of *Saba* and *Suleman*, see heading *Suleman*.

“سَبَّ” (*sabbahu*), “سَبَّأَ” (*sabba*): delinked it, sever it.
 “السَّبْبُ” (*as-subbu*): to swear, because it affects and severs relations between people {T}.
 “السَّبْبُ” (*as-sibbu*) and “السَّبْبُ” (*as-sababu*): long strong rope with the help of which one climbs a tree etc. or which is used to reach to the bottom of the water well.

This gave it the meaning of something through which one reaches something {T}. A road too is called “سَبَبٌ” (*sabab*) {R, M}, because it joins one destination with another. Hence this word also means relationship, or relative.

The Quran says:

2:116	Their mutual relations will be cut off (The means the mutual interests and benefits which were connecting them will end)	وَتَقَطَّعَتْ بِهِمُ الْأَسْبَابَ
18:98	He then took another direction	ثُمَّ اتَّبَعَ سَبَبًا
22:15	Then let him extend a “ladder” to the Heavens	فَلْيَمْدُدْ بِسَبَبٍ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ
20:37	Means reaching towards the Heavens {T}	أَسْبَابَ السَّمَوَاتِ

According to *Taj*, the word in 20:37 means steps or doors to the sky. *Abu zaid* says it means stages, {T}, and *Muheet* says it means steps, ways, surroundings or doors. The meanings of this word are wider and cover means and possibilities in carrying out some tasks.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:84	And we provided him all thing as means	وَآتَيْنَاهُ مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ سَبَبًا
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In the context of swearing, this root has been used in (6:108) where it is said that do not condemn or use bad language against the idols which the disbelievers worship, lest they react, and unconsciously further move away from Allah’s guidance. Such like events of mutual condemnation can take place among religious debates at emotive level.

“السُّبَاتُ” (*as-subaat*): sleep.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meanings of the word are of peace and tranquillity. Since peace and tranquillity meant that a man rested and stopped whatever he was doing, it got the meaning of ceasing to work or to cut it off {T}.

“سَبَتَ” (*sabat*), “يَسْبُتُ” (*yasbut*), “يَسْبُتُ” (*yasbitu*), “سَبَّأَ” (*sabta*): he rested {T}.

Raghib says that “سَبَّأَ” (*sabat*) means to close the business and to relax on a Saturday, to spend Saturday resting, to be around on a Saturday.

“سَبَّتَ الشَّيْءَ” (*sabatas shaiya*) means to cut off something.

“السَّبْبُ” (*as-sabt*) also means to shave something, like to shave the head.

“الْمَسْبُوتُ” (*al-masbuutu*): a corpse or an unconscious man. It also means a sick man who lies quietly with closed eyes {T}.

“يَوْمَ السَّبْتِ” (*yaumus-sabti*): the day of the week named Saturday. It is thought to be named so because on that day the Jews do not work {T}. Verse 2:65 has used this word in these meanings, and also to mean comfort and rest.

78:10	Created sleep to take to rest	وَجَعَلْنَا نَوْمَكُمْ سُبَاتًا
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In surah *Al-Furqaan* this is referred to this meaning as well, and “نُشُورًا” (*nushura*) has been used opposite to it (25:47) which means to walk, to scatter, to get up.

It is mentioned in the Quran that a group of Jews broke the agreement not to do business on Saturdays (4:154, 2:65). Surah *Al-Airaaf* says that they used to catch fish on that day (7:163). In violation of this agreed arrangement (not to catch fish on Saturday) they suffered the consequences (4:27) and this state was as a consequence of not following one their commitment as a community which led to divisions and parting of ways (16:124). This makes it obvious that when a system is followed then even the very small restriction needs to adhere otherwise gradually the whole system gets affected. The restriction of not working on a Saturday is a small restriction; however, it tests the character of individuals. Those who cannot resist such a small temptation, and try to make inroads into this rule created for the benefit of the society, they cannot be expected to observe the stricter rules? Character develops through self-discipline and by resisting temptation. By relating this event, Quran means to highlight this very fact. The consequences of their conduct which *Bani Israel* faced for going against these agreed restrictions is detailed under the heading (Q-R-D).

Hastings has written in his Encyclopaedia of Religious Ethics, with reference to various testaments, that *Sabat* would start on Friday evening and lasted the whole of Saturday. During this time there were 38 other restrictions besides trading which were prohibited.

S-B-H

س ب ح

“سَبَّحَ” (*sabh*): to swim.

“سَبَّحَ بِالنَّهْرِ” (*sabaha bin nahari*), “فِي النَّهْرِ سَبَّحًا” (*fi nahari sabhan*), “سَبَّاحَةً” (*sabaha*): he swam in a canal.

“أَسْبَحَهُ فِي الْمَاءِ” (*asbahu fil maa*): made him swim in water.

“السَّابِحَاتُ” (*as-sabihaat*): boats.

“السَّوَابِجُ” (*as-sawabih*): horses while running very fast move their limbs like a fast swimming action.

“السَّابَّاحُ” (*as-sabbbah*): a good swimmer, on a same pattern also used for a fast horse or a fast camel {T}.

“سَبَّحَ” (*sabh*): to venture far and wide in the quest for earning a living {T}.

“السَّابِحُ” (*as-sabh*) also means to experience travel through various lands {*Latif-ul-lugha*}.

Ibn Faris has said that it means a kind of pursuit, thus “سَبَّحَ” (*sabh*) means to strive very hard with utmost effort to achieve a goal, to strive with the maximum strength, to make sustained and continuous effort.

Taj-ul-Uroos has described a dream of *Ibn Shameel* in which he saw a person who was explaining the meaning of “سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ” (*subhan Allah*). He was explaining through the example of a horse which is going at a maximum speed like a fast swimmer. This means “سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ” (*subhan Allah*) to direct all efforts towards Allah as explained in the Quran and to remain steadfast in following the values {T}.

Raghib has also said that “سَبَّحًا” (*sabha*) means to go very fast in water or through air. Later it was allegorically used for the stars in the sky.

“السَّابِّحُ” (*as-sabih*) means to make haste in Allah’s obedience, but with passage of time the meaning expanded and was also used for spoken or practical worship {R}. Till this day “سُبَّحَةٌ” (*subh*) means beads of a rosary. Although this is not common among the Arabs, since rosaries were used by Christians in their worship, something they probably borrowed from Buddhists.

The Quran mentions about the celestial bodies:

36:40	they are all floating in their orbits	كُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ
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About the Messenger (*pbuh*) the Quran quotes:

73:7	for you, the daily program is very extensive and you have to work hard to get through it	إِنَّ لَكَ فِي النَّهَارِ سَبْحًا طَوِيلًا
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About birds it is said:

24:41	Each one of them knows their flight directions , though their flight path is not signposted	كُلٌّ قَدْ عَلِمَ صَلَاتَهُ وَتَسْبِيحَهُ
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It means that each bird knows how to go about its business, and each one is aware of its limits and the way it has to get means of subsistence.

57:1	Whatever there is in the universe is fully engaged in in carrying out the program designated for them through Allah's laws	سَبِّحْ لِلَّهِ مَا فِي السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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The things in the universe are instinctively tuned towards carrying out their programs. This is what has been described in the tale about Adam as the “تَسْبِيحُ” (*tasbeeh*) of the *Malaikas*: (2:31), or the “تَسْبِيحُ” (*tasbeeh*) of the thunder (13:13). But a man has to use his choice in order to complete the program. Hence believers are directed:

33:42	You should be engaged in carrying this program day and night (i.e. on continuous basis)	سَبِّحُوهُ بُكْرَةً وَأَصِيلًا
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About the programme itself, the direction is:

56:66	to get busy in implementing Allah's laws of subsistence (<i>Rabubiyah</i>), the programme on which the whole universe is functioning	فَسَبِّحْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ الْعَظِيمِ
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In a human society, the struggle against the opposing forces which obstruct the programme of subsistence is also called “ذِكْرُ” (*ziker*) and “تَسْبِيحُ” (*tasbeeh*). When *Musa (PBUH)* was directed to the Pharaoh, he too used these terms to define and explain his mission (20:34).

The system which Quran proposes for the believers places great importance on “صَلَاةُ” (*salaah*), which includes gathering for the prayer. These gatherings are physical manifestations of the group's acceptance of guidance from Allah. This is a manifestation in the form of “رُكُوعُ” (*ruku*) and “سُجُودُ” (*sajud*) which are translated to bowing and genuflecting. While doing this bowing and genuflecting, a believer agrees to follow and live according to Allah's laws and to spend his lifetime in implementing those laws in the society where he lives. The words in which this agreement is made are also termed as the “تَسْبِيحُ” (*tasbeeh*) of Allah. Obviously if a person only says so but fails practically follow it , then these utterances are mere rituals. The movements in *salaah* are the manifestations of one's motive to follow the guidance as explained in the Quran. If these gatherings are not followed through any actions and these become an end it then nothing positive will emerge in the real life. It is evident that by simply enumerating the attributes of Allah and by counting the beads of a rosary are not the actions the Quran has directed us to do. These rituals can never produce any results and result in waste of precious human time.

“تَسْبِيحُ” (*tasbeeh*), according to the Quran means to fully observe the laws of Allah by directing all efforts employing all resources to achieve desired results.

Lissan-ul-Arab says that “تَسْبِيحُ” (*tasbeeh*) means transcendence. It is used for saying “سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ” (*subhan Allah*), or mention of Allah, praise of Allah etc. Since the aspect of intensity is implicit in it, therefore *tanzia* would mean to consider Allah free from all limitations and weaknesses.

This root has the element of intensity and strength. As such “كِسَاءٌ مُسَبِّحٌ” (*kisaan musabbah*) means very strong and tightly knit blanket. Hence “فَسَبِّحْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ الْعَظِيمِ” (*fasibbah bismi rabbikal azeem*) would mean

to adopt the attributes of Allah as mentioned and explained in the Quran with total conviction and to propagate them widely for the benefit of others.

In Surah *As-Saffat* in context with *Yunus* it is noted:

37:143	He would have remained inside its belly until the Day of resurrection.	فَلَوْلَا أَنَّهُ كَانَ مِنَ الْمُسَبِّحِينَ لَلَبِثَ فِي بَطْنِهِ إِلَى يَوْمِ يُبْعَثُونَ
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If this word “مُسَبِّحِينَ” (*musabbihin*) had come from “سَبَّحَ” (*sabha*), then it would have meant swimmer. But since the word is according to “سَبَّحَ” (*sabbaha*), it would mean one who struggles with full might. This has the automatic connotation of struggling hard in order to stay away from the fish’s mouth and manage to swim ashore.

In the same surah it is said a little later:

37:162	We are verily to struggle very hard in this path	وَإِنَّا لَنَحْنُ الْمُسَبِّحُونَ
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These places too show that “تَسْبِيحٌ” (*tasbeeh*) means intensity, strength, and to engage in implementing Allah’s laws with strength and persistence.

“سُبْحَانَ” (*subhaana min kaza*) is said at times of wonderment {*T*}.

It also means “distance”:

37:159	Allah is far from these wrong concepts in which they believe	سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ عَمَّا يُصِفُونَ
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“سُبْحَانَ” (*subhaan*) also means to be engaged in something {*T*}.

30:17	You have to be engaged evening and morning in the duties assigned for you by Allah	فَسُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ حِينَ تُمْسُونَ وَحِينَ تُصْبِحُونَ
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S-B-Te

س ب ط

“السَّبْطُ” (*sabi*) basically means abundance and plentiful in something {*M, T, Sulbi*}.

Ibn Faris says it means for something to be prolonged.

It also means a tree which has one root but the branches are quite spread out. It also means family and descendants.

“السَّبِيطُ” (*as-sabit*) means grandson, regardless of the maternal or paternal side. This word is also used for a Jewish tribe.

“السَّبَاطُ” (*as-baat*) was a word used exclusive for the descendants of *Is-haq*, while “قَبَائِلُ” (*qabaa-il*) was used for the descendants of *Ismail*. The Arabs had kept this distinction to distinguish between the two branches of Ibrahim’s descendants with a single word {*M, T, Sulbi*}. In the Quran too, the word “السَّبَاطُ” (*asbaat*) has been used for the nation of *Moosa* (7:160). The Arabs used to call a non-arab as “السَّبِيطُ” (*sabi*), as they used to call the Arabs “جَعْدٌ” (*ja’d*). The Quran has also used “السَّبَاطُ” (*asbaat*) for the descendants of *Yaqoob* (2:136)

S-B-Ain

س ب ع

“سَبْعُ” (*sab-un*): means the figure seven, some think that in reality this word was “سَبْعَةٌ” (*sab-uh*) which means a lioness, because she attacks even faster than a lion. The Arabs thought the number seven to be a perfect number.

“السَّبْعُ” (*as-subuh*), “السَّبْعُ” (*as-sabah*) or “السَّبْعُ” (*as-sab'u*): means a wild animal (5:3), some think that this is so because the Arabs considered seven animals to be in the category of beasts.

Raghib says that wild animals are called “سَبْعُ” (*sabah*) because their strength is complete and the figure seven was also thought to be complete {*M, T, Sulbi*}.

Lane with reference to *Baizawi* has written that the Arabs not only meant seven by saying “سَبْعُ” (*sabah*) but it is also used to mean “several” or “many”.

“سَبْعُونَ” (*sab'on*) means seventy and “سَبْعُمِائَةٍ” (*sabame'atah*) means seven hundred {*M, T, R*}. As we sometimes say twenties, fifties, hundreds and do not mean any fixed figure, or as we sometime say ‘I have told you a hundred times’ to put emphasis. It does not mean an exact hundred.

For example the Quran says:

9:80	Even if you ask forgiveness for them seventy times	إِنْ تَسْتَغْفِرْ لَهُمْ سَبْعِينَ مَرَّةً
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It does not mean that if you ask for their pardon seventy times, we will not pardon them, but if you ask for their pardon more than seventy times then We will pardon them. It means that even if you ask pardon for them several times, they cannot be pardoned.

“سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ” (*sab'as samawaat*) is translated to numerous heavenly bodies (2:29). We also use the phrase ‘across seven seas’ by which we actually mean several seas.

2:261	Those who keep their wealth open i.e. spend for the benefit of other human beings, for them the wealth is like a seed which has seven saplings and there are a hundred grains in each sapling	الَّذِينَ يُنْفِقُونَ أَمْوَالَهُمْ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ كَمَثَلِ حَبَّةٍ أَتَتْ سَنَابِلَ فِي كُلِّ سَنَابِلٍ مِائَةُ حَبَّةٍ
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Obviously here “سَبْعَ سَنَابِلَ” (*sab-a sanabil*) means several.

The Quran says:

15:87	We have given you seven of the <i>misaani</i> and a great Quran.	وَلَقَدْ آتَيْنَاكَ سَبْعًا مِنَ الْمَثَانِي وَالْقُرْآنَ الْعَظِيمَ
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See the word “مَثَانِي” (*misaani*) in heading (Th-N-Y).

S-B-Gh

س ب غ

“السَّيِّغَةُ” (*as-sabagha*): vastness, expansiveness, generosity.

“سَبْعُ الشَّيْءِ” (*sabaghas shaiyi*), “سَبُوعًا” (*subugha*): for something (clothes, armour etc) to be long and hanging.

“السَّابِغَةُ” (*as-saabegha*): the armour which comes down to the level of knees or drags along the floor due to its length. Its plural is “سَابِغَاتٌ” (*saabeghaat*) (34:11).

“أَسْبَغَ شَعْرَهُ” (*asbagha sha'rah*): he let his hair grow very long.

“شَيْءٌ سَابِغٌ” (*shaiyun sabeghun*): a thing in full measure or abundance {*M, T, R*}.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is of being in full measure or abundance.

“سَبَعَتِ النِّعْمَةُ” (*sabaghatin ne'mah*): for the benevolence to be expansive and in abundance {*M, T, R*}.

The Quran says:

31:20	Allah endowed you with his benevolence in abundance	وَ أَسْبَغَ عَلَيْكُمْ نِعَمَهُ
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“سَبَقُ” (*sabq*) basically means to get ahead in a race. Later “سَبَقَهُ” (*sabaqah*) began to be used to mean exceed in everything, get ahead.

31:20	First the Messenger of Allah dies, and left the world, and after him <i>Abu Bakar</i> left the World as well	سَبَقَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ
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“السَّبَقُ” (*as-sabaqu*) is the prize which is given to the winner of any race e.g. horse race {T}.
 “اسْتَبَقَا الْبَابَ” (*istabaqal baab*): both of them leaped towards the door with each trying to go out ahead of the other (12:25) {T}.

Muheet says that if this word is followed by “عَلَى” (*ala*), then the thing which goes ahead or comes first, is harmful and if it is followed by “لِ” (*laam*) then the thing is beneficial.

21:101	... welcomed them with pleasure and went forward to greet them	سَبَقَتْ لَهُمْ مِنَّا الْحُسْنَى
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Surah *An-Naqarah* says:

2:148	Make effort to surpass one another in righteous deeds	فَاسْتَبِقُوا الْحَيْرَاتِ
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Psychologically, it is stated and believed that to compete and get ahead in life is a motivating force in people. It is the desire of competition and to get ahead that is something which keeps men busy. The Quran recognises this human emotion and asks us to develop it, and asks us to redirect our competitiveness into doing well for others. It says instead of getting ahead of others for personal gain try to excel one another in things which bring happiness to others. This will not only satisfy our desire (to get ahead) but will also prevent the chaos in society which would have occurred due to unbridled ambitions.

In surah *Al-Hijr*, this word of “تَسْبِقُ” (*tasbiq*) has appeared to mean “يَسْتَأْخِرُ” (*yastakhir*) which means to fall behind (15:5). At another place “مُسْتَقْدِمِينَ” (*mutaqdimeen*) has appeared against “مُسْتَأْخِرِينَ” (*mustaakhireen*) in 15:24.

Therefore “سَبَقُ اسْتِخَارَ” (*sabaqun istikhaaratun*) means the opposite of falling behind, and the same as “اسْتَقْدَامُ” (*istiqadaam*) i.e. to move forward.

Surah *Al-Waqiah* says “مُسْبُوفِينَ” (*musbooqeen*) in 56:60 i.e. the one who is “مَغْلُوبٌ” (*maghlub*), or surpassed.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says:

21:101	those for whom already our blessings have come (traditional translation)	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ سَبَقَتْ لَهُمْ مِنَّا الْحُسْنَى
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The above translation appears to imply as if God has already destined as to who will do good deeds and who will do evil deeds. This concept is against the Law of Requitat explained in the Quran. The above mentioned verse means that those who take the right path will have the positive results (because the result of such deeds is such) and this thing has been predetermined and those who follow the wrong path will have the negative consequences. There is no exception to this principle.

Surah *Al-Hadeed* says:

57:21	try to outdo each other in going towards (seeking for) your Sustainer's Protection	سَابِقُوا إِلَىٰ مَغْفِرَةٍ مِّن رَّبِّكُمْ
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Ibn Faris says that the basic meanings of this word are to hang, to leave and to elongate.

“أَسْبَلَ” (*asbal*): to hang, to leave.

“أَسْبَلَ الْأَزَارَ” (*asbalal izaar*): hanged *izaar*.

“أَسْبَلَ دَمْعَهُ” (*asbala dama'hu*): let his tears roll; let the tears roll so that they roll out of the eyes.

“أَسْبَلَتِ السَّمَاءُ” (*asbalatis sama'a*): it started to rain heavily from above.

“السَّبَلُ” (*as-sabal*): rain, but this the rain which is suspended above as clouds but has not yet reached on the ground

“السَّبْلَةُ” (*as-sublah*): rain on a wide scale.

“أَسْبَلَ الزَّرْعُ” (*asbalaz zar-u*): the ears began to hang in the crop {T}.

“السَّبِيلُ” (*as-sabeelu*) and “السَّبِيلَةُ” (*as-sabeelah*): path, an easy path where there is no harshness, or the distinct part of the path.

“سَبِيلٌ” (*sabeel*) is both masculine and feminine but as feminine its usage is more common. The plural is

“سَبِيلٌ” (*subul*) {T}.

Ibn Faris says that because a path goes a long way (due to its length), it is called “سَبِيلٌ” (*sabeel*).

“السَّبِيلَةُ مِنَ الطَّرِيقِ” (*as-sabilah minat turuq*): the path that people traverse generally on, or on which they come and go for fulfilling their needs, that is, the traveller {T}.

The Quran has used the phrase “فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ” (*fi sabeel Allah*) several times (2:190). Against it has appeared “فِي سَبِيلِ الطَّاغُوتِ” (*fi sabeelit taghut*) as in 4:76. The *Momineen* go to war “فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ” (*fi sabeel Allah*) and the *kafirs* go to war “فِي سَبِيلِ الطَّاغُوتِ” (*fi sabeelit taghut*) as said in 4:76. “الطَّاغُوتِ” (*at-taghut*) are those forces which are oppressive and force others to follow their dictates and establish the system of falsehood.

Therefore “فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ” (*fi sabeel Allah*) would mean for the observance of Allah's laws to establish Allah's system, and to traverse the path destined by Allah. They should do this act themselves as well as make others do the same. They should do this instead of following personal interests, and work for the interests of humanity at large. They should oppose the opposing forces. *Momineen* live and die for this very purpose. This also clarifies the meaning of “اتِّفَاقٌ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ” (*itifaaq fi sabeel Allah*) i.e. to keep one's wealth available or open for the benefit of mankind so that whatever is needed, can be taken from it.

“تَبْنِي السَّبِيلَ” (*ibnus sabeel*): traveller who travels a lot. Some think it means a traveller whose food during a journey has finished {T}. The Quran has also included among the duties of an Islamic society to help travellers. This duty is of such importance that it is one of the purposes of spending *sadaqaat* (9:10). This includes facilities for any traveller in an Islamic society, and those who in their travels become needy for any reason to help them to reach their destination.

Muheet has also said that it means guests. In today's terminology “ابن السبيل” (*ibnus sabeel*) would be those who come to an Islamic state and are in transit (i.e. even non-citizens).

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says about the people with the celestial book who used to say:

3:74	We can do whatever we want with these Arabs because they do not have a book, and nobody will hold us accountable	لَيْسَ عَلَيْنَا فِي الْأُمِّيِّينَ سَبِيلٌ
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This sort of mentality is born of tribal bias. According to it a crime within the tribe is a crime but if committed outside the tribe is not a crime. But this is not restricted to tribal societies. Even the Romans believed that theft within their own nation was theft, but outside the nation was not. The fact is that whether it is religious grouping or political, they give rise to the mentality that all benefits should be confined to the party members and all others outside the party are despised. This is taking place even today as it was a practice for four thousand years ago. Nationalism prevalent today as a product of such thinking, and this very thing has turned the world into a sort of hell i.e. mutual conflicts. The Quran raised its voice against this sort of thinking and declared that a crime is a crime no matter it is against the people

of your kind or others. There is no difference among nations or human beings in this respect. That is why any deed which is done “فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ” (*fi sabeel Allah*) is a good deed which is without any thought of remuneration or compensation, and is for the benefit of the whole mankind.

The Quran has said about the heavenly life:

76:18	It has a spring which is named <i>salsabeel</i>	عَيْنًا فِيهَا تُسَمَّى سَلْسَبِيلًا
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Muheet says that the root is “سَلَّ سَبِيلًا” (*sal-sabeela*) which means to find out about the way, i.e. to ask the way and move forward. It means the “river” that flows to satisfy the needs of all, and which does not differentiate.

At another place is said:

88:12	flowing spring (the spring which flows all the time)	فِيهَا عَيْنٌ جَارِيَةٌ
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The spring of life which keeps flowing forward; the eternal life which is the logical outcome of good deeds which goes forward continuously without interruption? It has no interruption whatsoever. It means that for human personality to keep traversing the path ahead. “سَبِيلُ اللَّهِ” (*sabeel Allah*) is the path, the direction on which man sticks to “مَائِنْفَعُ النَّاسِ” (*ma yanfa unnaas*) for the good of mankind as mentioned in (13:17). This is the path towards which Allah’s messenger invited mankind, because he knew the benefits of it through his insight which was developed through the evidence and the understanding of the Quran based on intellectual reasoning (12:108).

This is the right path as outlined by the Quran. By following this path the human abilities can develop to their utmost because “مَسَلَا السَّكَاسِ إِلَى أَسْبَالِهَا” (*malal kaasa ila asbaalaha*): it is said to fill the cup to the brim {T}.

In surah *An-Nahal* the bee has been directed instinctively:

16:19	Follow the path laid out by your Sustainer.	فَاسْلُكِي سَبِيلَ رَبِّكِ ذُلُلًا
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This shows that the laws of nature are also the paths of God. For the mankind the right paths are the ones conveyed by the messengers as revealed to them through the revelation as noted in (14:12).

Surah *Al-Ankabuut* says:

29:69	Those who struggle for Us are shown the way (the right path) by us. Allah is with those who do the righteous deeds.	وَالَّذِينَ جَاهَدُوا فِينَا لَنَهْدِيَنَّهُمْ سُبُلَنَا - وَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَمَعَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ
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There is only one path that leads towards Allah and that has been called by Him as “صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ” (*siraatul mustaqeem*) or the right path (1:5). But man is faced by new problems and challenges every now and then, as the life progresses. The Quran has broadly laid down the principles of life for the mankind, it is the duty of the believers to find the solution to these problems in the light of these principles. Obviously this requires knowledge about the universe, about the social life of the nations of this world, an understanding of the needs of the times, and deep deliberation on the permanent values of the Quran. To struggle to find a solution to the problems facing us from the guidance which the Quran provides is called in the Quranic terms as “اجتهاد” (*ijtehaad*). It is Allah’s promise that those who strive in this way, He will enhance their understanding and broaden their vision. This will help them to understand the issues of life and they will be able to resolve these as per the guidance of the Quran. This direction is defined and explained by the Quran as the “سَبِيلُ السَّلَامِ” (*subul islam*) or the paths of tranquillity and protection.

At another place their purpose is described as:

5:16	to bring them out of darkness into light	يُخْرِجُهُم مِّنَ الظُّلُمَاتِ إِلَى النُّورِ بِإِذْنِهِ
5:16	and thus they are guided to the right path	وَيَهْدِيهِمْ إِلَى صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ

This also means that all these paths lead to the same “highway” called the guidance; whatever the group of **Momineen** decides while remaining within the confines of the Quranic values to meet the requirements of the time will always aim at the overall guidance which will serve as a criterion.

S-T-T

س ت ت

“السَّتُّ” (*as-seet*), “السَّتَّةُ” (*as-sittah*): the number of six. It was actually “سِتْدُسُ” (*sids*) at first {*T*}.

The Quran says:

7:75	created the earth and the heavens in six periods	خَلَقَ السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ فِي سِتَّةِ أَيَّامٍ
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There is a reference to the different stages through which the earth and other heavenly bodies have passed before these reached the present stage. For the correct meaning of “يَوْمٌ” (*yaum*), see (Y-W-M). “سِتُونُ” (*situun*) and “سِتِّينَ” (*sitteen*) means sixty (58:2).

S-T-R

س ت ر

“سِتْرٌ” (*sitr*): veil, some type of a cover which is used to hide something.

Surah *Al-kahaf* says:

18:90	they lived in the open ground so that there was no obstruction between them and the sun	لَمْ يَجْعَلْ لَهُمْ مِنْ دُونِهَا سِتْرًا
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“السَّتَارُ” (*as-sitar*): veil.

“سَتَرَ الشَّيْءَ” (*satarash shaiyi*): he hid that thing.

“اِسْتَتَرَ” (*istatar*): to hide {*T, R, M*}.

The Quran says:

41:22	You were not hidden	وَمَا كُنْتُمْ تَسْتَرَوْنَ
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In Surah *Bani Israel* it is stated that when you recite the Quran, between you and the people who do not wish to believe in the life hereafter:

17:45	a veil descends	حِجَابًا مَسْثُورًا
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Though this veil is not visible with eyes, but it can be understood as it prevents them from coming to the message. Their psychological state has been described as “حِجَابٌ مَسْثُورٌ” (*hijabun mastoor*), that is, a meta-physical cover. “مِسْثُورٌ” (*mistoor*) also means the same as “سَاعِرٌ” (*sa'ir*) which means one who hides. Likewise “مَسْخُورٌ” (*mashoor*) is the same as “سَاحِرٌ” (*saahir*) which means sorcerer. One of Gods attributes is “السَّاتِرُ” (*as-sattar*) commonly referred, but this attribute has not been mentioned in the Quran.

“السُّجُودُ” (*as-sujud*): to bow the head.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be low or to bend over.

“نَخْلَةٌ سَاجِدَةٌ” (*nakhlatur sajidah*): a date palm that is bent, especially one which bends under the weight of its fruit {T}.

“سَجَدَ الْبَعِيرُ” (*sajadal baeer*): the camel bent its neck so that the man could mount on its back {T}.

Therefore, this root refers to (physically) someone bowing his head or some other thing to bend down (or bow). However, behind the human mannerism there is a philosophy and in modern terms it is called parallelism. It means that there is a profound connection between one's mind and body, and these two function in parallel. For example, if we are lying down and decide to do something, then we get up as the thought crosses our mind. When we wish to rest, we either sit down or lie down, or when we say 'yes' we nod our head (automatically and unconsciously). When we have respect for someone, our hand may rise to our forehead (for a salute) and if our respect transcends this, then we may even bow before that person to express out profound respect. These actions also affect our speech which is a translation of our bodily movements, or expresses the same emotions that the body movements signify. For example, when we say that he bowed his head at my order, you actually mean that he has accepted to carry out your order. When we say that he rebelled against the law of the state, then we mean that he has refused to accept the state's law and chose to go against it. Since the Quran speaks in a particular language (Arabic), it too uses the metaphors of this language to express itself clearly. In this context, it has used the words “سجده” (*sajdah*) to mean obedience and acceptance and is not referring to the act of physical bowing.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:49	And all living things which are in the highs and lows of the universe bow before Allah and do not rebel (following laws)	وَلِلَّهِ يَسْجُدُ مَا فِي السَّمُوتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ مِنْ دَابَّةٍ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُمْ لَا يَسْتَكْبِرُونَ
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Here “يَسْجُدُ” (*yashudu*) has been explained by “لَا يَسْتَكْبِرُونَ” (*la yastakbiruun*), i.e. they do not disobey the orders of Allah but instead follow them. The verse is further explained by:

16:50	they carry out what they are directed to do	وَيَفْعَلُونَ مَا يُؤْمَرُونَ
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Therefore, the root of this word (S-J-D) must be kept in mind to determine whether it means a physical bowing or a figurative bowing which is to express obedience.

For the difference between religion and *Deen*, see headings (Dh-H-B) and (D-Y-N).

Another point should also be considered at this stage. When the human mind was in its infancy (like a child), it understood only the physical things and mostly used to express himself in physical terms. In today's terminology his knowledge was restricted to “sense perception”. He had not yet reached the stage of having abstract concepts or to acquire knowledge through them. Therefore, his religion, like other things, was limited to this sense-perception. This means that he was still in the stage of formalism. To represent God, he had created idols. In worship etc. the stress was on the form of worship rather than the spirit. In fact, form had become the end in itself.

The Quranic teaching treats a man like an adult with developed intellect, reasoning, and perception. It can be said that the Quran wants human begins to come out of the nascent stage and into the adulthood. Therefore the Quran stresses on conceptual knowledge as well as on conceptual knowledge. In the matter of *Deen* the Quran stresses on the purpose while keeping the form without rejecting the later. This is because human beings wish some visible form to express their ideas. It stresses on the intention rather than the form, but it does not altogether do away with the form, but retains some part of it. We see that the great philosophers and thinkers use facial expressions and hands to explain ideas and concepts. This gesturing is part of human expression. In this way thinkers explain abstract truths with examples taken

from physical world. This is the reason that the Quran, despite man having evolved much higher than the perceptual stage, has retained some form. The practice of bowing in prayers is a manifestation of this form. For example, in Surah *An-Nisa* (4:102) where observing prayer during a battle has been mentioned, it has also been said that one group may establish the prayer and when it is finished, then the other group observe their prayer.

Obviously here “سجدة” (*sajdah*) means to physically bow one’s head before God, like was the practice of our messenger *Muhammed* (*pbuh*) and his followers. In the Quran, prayer and *Hajj* are two things in which some form has been retained. These two are collective prayers and it is necessary to have some uniformity in the collective form of worship. If in a collective gathering, every individual adopts his own form of worship, then one can well imagine the chaos this may create. More details about these matters can be found under the heading (Sd-L-W).

It is obvious that for a man to bow physically before God is the physical display of man’s emotions and intentions towards God and that he accepts God’s Laws willingly without any reservation. If his visible act of bowing is not a display of his inner feeling of acceptance and is purely a display of the worship procedure then this whole practice of worshipping is meaningless and this will never produce any positive result.

This is the truth for which the Quran has said:

2:177	The righteousness is not to turn your face towards the east or the west, but it is whether you truly believe with conviction in Allah, the hereafter), universal forces, revelation through His books and the messengers who brought the revelation, and give wealth, despite the love of it, to relatives (who need it) , orphans, needy, travellers, and the oppressed	لَيْسَ الْبِرُّ أَنْ تُوَلُّوا وُجُوهَكُمْ قِبَلَ الْمَشْرِقِ وَالْمَغْرِبِ وَلَكِنَّ الْبِرَّ---
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This means that “صلوة” (*salaah*) is actually a physical display of man’s acceptance of the Quran as a book of guidance and a commitment to follow the values therein. If man takes the “صلوة” (*salaah*) only as an end in itself, then it holds no importance with God and man will never reap the benefits which one can only get by following the Quran as a whole. Instead the Quran says:

107:5-7	There is loss to those who pray but ignore the essence of the prayer (as stated earlier) and perform the obvious trappings of the <i>salaat</i> to show people. Indeed the same people prevent the flow of the capital for the good of the wider public and hoard it for themselves.	فَوَيْلٌ لِلْمُصَلِّينَ الَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ الَّذِينَ هُمْ يُرَاءُونَ وَيَتَعَفَّوْنَ الْمَاعُتُونَ
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“المسجد” (*al-masjid*): forehead which touches the ground (during bowing), and “المسجد” (*al-masjid*) is the place where *sajdah* is performed {T}. This is a pronoun and can mean both the place where the *sajdah* is performed and the time when it is done.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says that people built a *masjid* (or mosque) near the cave where these young men had escaped to (18:21). They were “مجاهدين” (*mujahideen*) i.e. those who struggled in life and lived a righteous life. But later (as usually happens) the truth disappeared and in their memory a monument was built which became a place for *sajdah* or worship.

In surah *Bani Israel* the *heckel* (a synagogue) of the Jews has been called *masjid* (17:7).

Surah *At-Taubah* also mentions the *masjid* or mosque during the times of the messenger (*pbuh*) which was based on “تقوى” (*taqwah*) (9:109). It also mentions another mosque which was built with a view to create divisions among the Muslims, which the Quran has termed as *kufri* and the sanctuary for those fighting a war against Allah and His Messenger (*pbuh*) (9:107). The Quran has declared sectarianism as *shirk* (i.e. associating other gods with Allah His sharing sovereignty), and clearly stated that the *mushrikeen*, that is, those who follow other laws and associate these with Allah have no right to be in these *masjids* associated with Allah.

The Quran declared:

72:18	The <i>masjids</i> are only for Allah, so do not call on others along with Allah.	أَنَّ الْمَسْجِدَ لِلَّهِ فَلَا تَدْعُوا مَعَ اللَّهِ أَحَدًا
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Sectarianism or causing divisions is forbidden and is declared a crime because it moves us away from the guidance and the values as revealed in the Quran and it prevents us from getting the benefits associated with the following of the Quran. If the believers follow the Quran then there cannot be any divisions as they will be moving away from their own desires which vary from individual to individual. The Quran has declared that there is no contradiction within the guidance (4:82) and those who follow it the way it is explained then they will be free from any contradiction as well.

Just as *sajdah* means not only to put your forehead on the ground but also to follow the Quranic Laws, so *masjid* is not just the place or building where people go for the prayer ritual. It means the centre which is the symbol for establishing Allah's laws on earth. The "كعبة" (*kaaba*) Mecca has been declared "مَسْجِدٌ الْحَرَامِ" (*masjidil haram*) in 28:27. This is not because people perform *sajda* there, but because it is the centre which represents the System which symbolises the Unity of Allah.. It is the centre for the Muslim nation because of being "مُسْلِمَةٌ لَكَ" (*muslimata alak*) (2:128) i.e. a nation which symbolises the Quranic Laws.

Historically, after the Messenger's (*pbuh*) migration to Medina from Mecca, Medina was to become the centre of the Quranic system, therefore (regarding the night of migration) Medina has been called "مَسْجِدٌ الْأَقْصَا" (*masjid al-aqsa*) in the Quran, which means the mosque far away.

17:1	Glory to Allah Who did take His servant by a night journey from Mecca to the mosque far away, whose precincts We did bless- in order that We show him some of Our Signs.	سُبْحَنَ الَّذِي أَسْرَى بِعَبْدِهِ لَيْلًا مِّنَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ الْأَقْصَا الَّذِي بَرَكْنَا حَوْلَهُ لِنُرِيَهُ مِنْ آيَاتِنَا
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After this, *Moosa(pbuh)* has been referred as noted in surah *Taha* where he has been ordered to go towards the Pharaoh. There too similar wording is used:

20:22	so that We show you Our big signs	لِنُرِيكَ مِنْ آيَاتِنَا الْكُبْرَى
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This sign was *Moosa's* success in the struggle against the Pharaoh. This was also the sign which after the Messenger's (*pbuh*) migration, from Mecca to Medina, was to be manifested as the later events indicate which ultimately led to the establishment of a model welfare state as directed in the Quran. It represents the victory of the believers over the forces which were defending the system based on human exploitation. This brings the fact before us that the building of a mosque is for a gathering of those who have one ideology and is to resolve the human issues within the values and boundaries laid down by the Quran. The human issues cannot be resolved through the existing concept of worship which is to satisfy some self - created emotional need to please a concept of god which is quite different from the concept of Allah explained in the Quran. The term used in the Quran has nothing to do with the concept of worship – it is about dealing with the human issues with a view to providing an environment for the development of the human self. This is to provide an option to those who think and reason to use their free will and deal with the human issues on a global basis. See heading (Ain-B-D) and any steps taken within the Quranic values are part and parcel of the concept of "عبادة" (*ibadat*). The existing gatherings for prayers do not achieve this purpose and have become ritualised and are in a gross need of revision in the light of the Quranic guidance.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:31	O mankind take you adornment to every <i>masjid</i>	يٰۤاَيُّهَا آدَمُ خُذُوْا زِيْنَتَكُمْ عِنْدَ كُلِّ مَسْجِدٍ
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Here masjid has been used to mean to obey, to follow {*Lisan-ul-Arab*}.

In this verse, a great truth has been revealed. Christianity (and other religions) term monasticism as the height of obedience and worship, i.e. to give up the pleasures of this life and this world. This concept has been refuted by the Quran as it leads to lack of challenging environment which is required for the development of the human self, and the use of the adornment within the confines of the permanent values is a way forward and helps to enjoy this life and paving the way for the next one. As the Quran deals with the issues of the Self's development and wishes us to partake in this life as much as possible on a continuous basis through our physical self. More activity within the confines of these values widens the sphere of human choices at self's level. For example all those beliefs which hamper our decisions making disappear and very confident self emerges which has only one belief based on conviction and which uses Allah as an ultimate Self as a model. The self's sphere of choices increase which has no bounds and which extends beyond the geographical limits of this universe. One should of course benefit from world's good things while remaining within the limits defined within the Quran. The Quran invites us to use our body to develop our self which is the true entity and whose nourishment is the purpose of our life. The next part of this verse and the next verse has clarified this meaning by saying:

7:31	Eat and drink but do not transgress the limits. Allah does not like those who transgress the limits	وَكُلُوا وَاشْرَبُوا وَلَا تُسْرِفُوا إِنَّهُ لَا يُحِبُّ الْمُسْرِفِينَ
7:32	Say, who has forbidden the good things of this life which Allah has created (for the use of mankind)	قُلْ مَنْ حَرَّمَ زِينَةَ اللَّهِ الَّتِي أَخْرَجَ لِعِبَادِهِ وَالطَّيِّبَاتِ مِنَ الرِّزْقِ--

Two verses earlier say:

7:29	Say, Allah has directed you to be just and direct your faces towards his guidance and call upon him with total commitment and intensity	قُلْ أَمَرَ رَبِّي بِالْقِسْطِ وَأَقِيمُوا وُجُوهَكُمْ عِندَ كُلِّ مَسْجِدٍ وَادْعُوهُ مُخْلِصِينَ لَهُ الدِّينَ--
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Surah *Al-Fatah* says about the Messenger (*pbuh*) and those with him:

48:29	You will find them in <i>rukuh</i> and in <i>sajdah</i>	تَرَاهُمْ رُكَّعًا سُجَّدًا
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Here if literal meaning of *rukuh* and *sujud* are taken, then it would mean collective prayer and if figurative meanings are taken, then it would mean taking defined responsibilities and functioning within the confines of the limits defined by the Quran.

After this it is said:

48:29	they can be recognized by the signs on their faces	سَيَمَاهُمْ فِي وُجُوهِهِمْ مِنْ أَثَرِ السُّجُودِ
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This means that the peace and tranquillity which they get by following the permanent values as revealed in the Quran, become evident from their personality and body language. The internal stable state of the human Self displays its confidence and strength through its value driven decisions making and their results.

The Quran says:

55:41	The criminals will be recognized from their personality and conduct	يُعَرَفُ الْمُجْرِمُونَ بِسِيمَاهُمْ
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Here too an aspect of the human psyche is referred where the inner state at times gives clues through the body language and the face expressions. The calmness and the confidence which one gets through following the righteous path translate at times into our conduct and appearance.

“سَجَرَ النَّوْرَ” (*sajarat tanur*), “يَسْجُرُهُ” (*yasjuruh*), “سَجْرًا” (*sajra*): lighten a clay oven, putt maximum fuel to heat it up, to fill with fuel e.g. wood, coal.

“سَجَرَ النَّهْرَ” (*shajaran nahar*): he filled the canal.

“السَّجُورُ” (*as-sajur*): the thing with which the oven is stoked.

“الْمَسْجِرُ” (*al-masjir*): wooden rod with which fuel in an oven is moved around so it may heat up quickly.

“السَّاجِرُ” (*as-saajir*), “الْمَسْجُورُ” (*al-masjur*): immobile and filled thing. It also means to fill an empty thing, thus it means opposites {*Latif-ul-Lugha*}. It means the flood water which is more than the river can contain.

“سَجَرْتُ الْإِنَاءَ” (*sajartul ina'a*): I filled the pot.

“السَّاجِرُ” (*as-saajir*): the plain from which the flood passes and fills it up the area.

“بِعَرْ سَجِرٍ” (*beirun sajir*): a filled well {*T*}.

“سَجَرَ الْمَاءَ” (*sajjarul ma'u*): for the water to make its own way {*T*}. This word means to flare up a fire as well as to fill something up and be full.

Ibn Faris says it means (1) to fill, (2) to meet up, and (3) to flare up or instigate.

The Quran says:

40:72	Then they will be pushed into the fire	ثُمَّ فِي النَّارِ يُسْجَرُونَ
52:6	Filled sea (or adjoining sea)	الْبَحْرُ الْمَسْجُورُ
81:6	The oceans will be busy with shipping all around	إِذَا الْبِحَارُ سُجِّرَتْ

If “بَحَارٌ” (*bihaars*) is taken to mean the settlements along the shores, then it would mean that ports and harbours will be inhabited and busy. However the meaning remains the same.

“السَّجْلُ” (*as-sajl*): a big bucket (of the well) filled with water, philanthropist {*T*}.

“السَّجْلُ” (*as-sijllu*): book, document, writer {*T*}.

“السَّجِيلُ” (*as-sijjeel*): it is a Persian word that has been arabized from “سَنَگِ گِلَ” (*sang-e-gul*) i.e. clay which is hardened in fire. In the old days when people began to write, slates of clay were ‘cooked’ in the fire and hardened and were used to write on. This was called “السَّجْلُ” (*as-sijl*). Later everything which was used to write was called “السَّجْلُ” (*as-sijl*) {*R*}.

The Quran says that on the nation of *Loot*:

11:82	were rained upon	حِجَارَةً مِنْ سِجِّيلٍ
51:33	were rained upon	حِجَارَةً مِنْ طِينٍ

At both places they were called “مُسَوَّمَةٌ عِنْدَ رَبِّكَ” (*musawwamatun inda rabbika*): (51:34, 11:83). That is, those who were marked by Allah for this purpose {*T*}. But “السَّجْلُ” (*as-sijl*) has an element of writing and this too elaborates the meaning of “مُسَوَّمَةٌ” (*musawwamath*). Maybe they were “مَنْصُودٌ” (*manzood*) layer upon layer (11:82) or slates which were in a library atop the mountain and when the volcano erupted these fell on the inhabitations around it. This refers to the physical destruction caused in the historical context which affected the earlier nations from the past.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says:

21:104	This will be the era when heights or people belonging to the upper echelons of society will be wrapped up like paper	يَوْمَ نَطْوِي السَّمَاءَ كَطَيِّ السِّجِلِّ لِلْكُتُبِ
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This verse is signifying that “their era has ended, now economic egalitarianism will take place” (39:67). If there is a reference to the celestial bodies in this verse then it would mean the wrapping up of the heavenly bodies.

Ibn Faris says the root basically means for something to be over filled and then spill over.

S-J-N

س ج ن

“سَجَنَ” (*sajan*), “يَسْجُنُ” (*yasjun*), “سَجْنًا” (*sajna*): to imprison someone {*T*}. (12:35, 12:25).
 “السَّجْنُ” (*as-sijn*): prison (12:33).

“سَجَّيْنُ” (*sijjeen*): this word has appeared in surah *At-Tatfeef*:

83:3	And what can make you know what this <i>sijjeen</i> is?	مَا أَذْرَاكَ مَا سَجَّيْنُ
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Some have translated it as prisons. However, the Quran explained it by saying:
 Some say that “سَجَّيْنُ” (*sijjeen*) means prison, but the Quran has also said:

83:9	It is a written scripture (a chronicle of deeds)	كِتَابٌ مَرْقُومٌ
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A chronicle of deeds a man does in his lifetime and record, like a written book with all details {*T*, *R*}.

S-J-W

س ج و

“سَجَا اللَّيْلُ يَسْجُو” (*sajjal lailu yasju*), “سَجْوًا” (*sajwa*): for the night to become silent, to stop, to become dark.

Ibn Faris includes tranquillity and to cover in its basic meanings.

“سَجَا اللَّيْلُ” (*sajjal lail*) means for the night to be very dark and quiet.

“الْبَحْرُ السَّاجِي” (*al-bahru-saaji*): peaceful sea.

“الطَّرْفُ السَّاجِي” (*at-tarfus saaji*): quiet look.

Ibnul Airaabi says that “سَجَى اللَّيْلُ” (*sajjal lail*) means that the darkness of the night increased {*T*, *R*}.

The Quran says:

93:2	The darkness of the night and the intensity of the darkness before dawn is a testimony	وَاللَّيْلُ إِذَا سَجَى
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This testimony is to the fact that this program of Allah’s system will take some time to reach success and it will complete its stages before doing so. As such you find that despite your best efforts, the darkness of society is not being eliminated, then do not let this make you reach the conclusion that Allah’s laws have left your side.

93:3	Neither has your Sustainer left your side nor put you in trouble for nought	مَا وَدَّعَاكَ رَبُّكَ وَمَا قَلَى
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With “وَالضُّحَى” (*wadduha*) appearing with it, it can also mean that the changes of day and night are testimony to the fact that the opposition will always not remain so, and there will be a revolution, and that things will change for the better.

“سَحَبَ” (*sahib*): he pulled, dragged.

“الْمَرْأَةُ تَسْحَبُ ذَيْلَهَا” (*almar'atuh tashabu zailaha*): the woman drags the corner of her dress on the ground.

“اِنْسَحَبَ” (*insahab*): he dragged (along) on the ground.

“السَّحَابَةُ” (*as-sahabah*): which means dark clouds, a piece of cloud, because it pulls the water (from the sea), or the winds pull it, or it drags itself across the sky. The plural is “سَحَابٌ” (*sahaab*).

In the Quran, this word has been used both as singular and plural.

2:165	cloud which has been in control	السَّحَابِ الْمُسَخَّرِ
13:12	very thick and dark clouds	السَّحَابِ الثَّقَالِ
40:71	They will be pulled (or dragged) into the 'hameem' (hell fire)	يُسْحَبُونَ فِي الْحُومِ
54:28	The day they will be dragged to fire	يَوْمَ يُسْحَبُونَ فِي النَّارِ

“السَّحْتُ” (*as-seht*): to uproot something, to pare something gradually.

“سَحَتِ الشَّحْمَ عَنِ اللَّحْمِ” (*sahatas sahma unil lahm*): pared off the fat from the surface of the meat {T},

The Quran says:

20:61	He will punish them such that they will be eliminated	فَيُسْحَتُكُمْ بِعَذَابٍ
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“السُّحْتُ” (*as-suht*): everything which is forbidden to mention, a forbidden and dirty profession which is the cause of shame. Every forbidden and unacceptable sustenance which is deprived of the blessings of God {T}.

About the Jews it is said:

5:42	their means of earning is execrable	أَكْلُونِ لِلْسُّحْتِ
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Commonly the Jews were prone to charging interest and their religious scholars did business under the cover of their religion i.e. gave religious edicts for profit. Not just the Jews, but capitalists and religious leadership is the same everywhere.

Muheet with reference to *Qeys* says that “سُحْتُ” (*suht*) is that thing which is clearly forbidden and there is no doubt about it being so.

“حَرَامٌ سُحْتُ” (*haraamun suht*) means forbidden and well known to everyone.

“أَرْضٌ سُحْتَاءُ” (*arzun sahata-u*) means a barren piece of land {T}.

“عَامٌ أَسْحَتْ” (*aamu ashat*): drought year during which there is no growth e.g. fodder {T}.

Muheet says “السَّحَرُ” (*as-sehr*) basically means to turn, and figuratively it means to represent falsehood as truth.

Tahzeeb says it means to turn something away from the truth to untruth.

Taj-ul-Uroos says it means such things whose origin is such that it becomes difficult to separate fact from fiction. It is used for a deception of a sort that one cannot find out how the deception has been made. Later this word started meaning commonly used techniques of cheating and deception {Ibn Qatebah}.

“سَحَرَهُ” (*saharah*) and “سَحَرَهُ” (*sah-harah*): he was deceived.

“إِنَّمَا أَنْتَ مِنَ الْمُسَحَّرِينَ” (*nama unta minal musah hareen*): you all are among those who have been deceived, and are deceived time and again (26:153-158).

“عَنْزُ مَسْحُورَةٍ” (*unzun mashurah*) means a goat which has big breasts but it produces little milk.

“الْمَسْحُورُ” (*almas-huur*) means someone whose mind has gone mad or someone who lost his mind {T, M}.

The opponents used to call the messenger (*pbuh*) as “رَجُلًا مَسْحُورًا” (*rajulan mas huura*), that is, one who has been deceived, or one who is under a spell, or one whose intellect has been impaired (17:47). It also means the same as “سَاحِرٌ” (*saahir*), or one who deceives, as in 17:101.

Surah *Al-Mominoon* says:

23:89	Ask them why have you been deceived?	قُلْ قَاتِلِي تُسْحَرُونَ
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Aside from deception, this word also means lies. The Quran says:

11:7	If you tell them that you will be raised after you are dead then the deniers will say that this is a lie.	وَلَيْنِ قُلْتَ إِنَّكُمْ مَبْعُوثُونَ مِنْ بَعْدِ الْمَوْتِ لَيَقُولَنَّ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا إِنْ هَذَا إِلَّا سِحْرٌ مُبِينٌ
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“السَّحَرُ” (*as-sahar*) means the upper part of the chest, (lung, heart etc.). It means the corner of everything.

“سَحَرٌ” (*sahar*) is the last part of the night, or just before dawn.

Raghib says that *sahar* means dawn, when the darkness of the night is changing into the light of day (54:34). The plural is “أَسْحَارٌ” (*ashaar*) as in 51:18 {T}.

Ibn Qateebah says that *sahar* means the beginning of a day, the time for commencing business.

History tells us that in the past there has been a time which has been called the magical age. Western researchers have provided quite a bit of information about this era. *Sehr* or magic meant that people through various means tried to make various forces in the universe follow their orders or desires. This is what is known as sorcery as well. First came the era in which man pleaded to the forces in the universe, then came the era when he thought of forcing these forces to do what he wanted. Thus sorcerers had a very high stature in society, but if given careful thought, it will be seen that man's development from the era of worship to the era of magic was a first and childish attempt to develop rational thinking, 'Rational thought' means to find the cause of everything, to find out the cause and effect of everything. In the era of worship man thought, for instance, that a man suffers from fever because some deity was displeased with him. To get rid of this fever one needed to please that deity somehow. There was no cause and effect inquiry into the matter. From this man evolved to the era of magic, in other words, he thought if such mantra is read so many times, and in a certain way, then the aim will be achieved. That is, in his mind a faint linkage with deed and effect had begun to make a beginning. Allah's *deen* told him that everything in the universe is created by Allah. Every deed has a designated effect and this happens according to certain law. If man finds out about the laws then he can produce the effect any time he wants. This is the foundation on which our entire scientific structure rests, and the axis round which human life and his

future revolves. Magic is false illusion only, because it does not have any concept of something happening due to a certain law, but because of reciting some mantras and to do some odd things.

The Quran invited mankind to rationally analyse everything in their world by using their intellect and reasoning. In the Quran, in the story about *Moosa*, there is mention of the sorcerers of the Pharaoh's nation and their sorcery. *Moosa* had dealt with them. If *sehr* means magic then at these places it will be taken to mean magicians, but if it means 'the worship of falsehood, then the figurative meanings of those verses will be taken accordingly.

If *sehr* is taken to mean magic, then one thing comes to fore. The Quran has said that these sorcerers deceived people's eyes (7:116), that is, the ropes they had thrown on the ground did not actually start to move. The sorcerers with sleight of hand or psychologically made the people think that they had moved. That is, this sort of magic only affects the power of thought and those things do not actually turn into something different. The magician affects the power of thinking of the people who are watching. Today's psychological advancement has proven that it can be done and is called illusion. That means that nothing more than our thoughts make this magic real. The point to note here is that the Quran exposed the existence of these types of tricks from the past which took place many centuries ago. Also see heading (Kh-Y-L).

The entire religion of the Jews seemed to have got infested and comprises of such sorcery and their places of worship were the centres of such sorcery. They used to attribute these things to *Suleman* (Solomon). *Ism azam* and *nuqooshi sulemaani* (the great name and the seal of Solomon) were their special gimmicks for creating such magic. The Quran refuted all this and said that the messengers of God have nothing to do with these deceptions and superstitions (2:102).

This is what the Quran said but the *Muslims* who are supposed to follow the Quran gradually got influenced by superstitions one after another, and by naming it spiritualism gave falsehood the appearance of the truth. They only deceived themselves.

The Messenger (*pbuh*) was accused to be:

17:47 25:8	he is under a spell	رَجُلًا مَسْحُورًا
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The Quran has denied this in 25:9. The personality of a messenger is so strong and developed through the use of intellect and reasoning within the values of the revelation that no sorcerer's psychological strength can influence it. The messenger could never have come under any spell, as it is impossible. In *Moosa's* story it has only been said that he thought that the ropes were moving, but this is a different thing, while to be under someone's spell and talk nonsense is quite different. Messengers can never be under a spell. If in this tale about *Moosa*, *sehr* is taken to mean worship of false ideologies, then the meaning becomes clearer.

S-H-Q

س ح ق

“سَحَقَ” (*suhaqa*), “يَسْحَقُ” (*yashaquh*), “سَحَقًا” (*sahqa*): he hammered it or ground into fine (powder).
 “اِسْحَقَ” (*insahaq*): he was ground (burdened).
 “سَحَقَتِ الرِّيحُ الْأَرْضَ” (*sahaqatir rihul ard*): the wind blew away the marks in the ground; it blew so hard as if it was grinding the earth.
 “سَحَقَتِ الدَّابَّةُ” (*sahaqatil da-abbah*): the animal ran fast.
 “اِسْحَقُ” (*as-suhuq*), “اَلْسُحُقُ” (*as-sahuq*) means to be distant.
 “اَسْحَقَ فُلَانًا” (*as-haqi fulana*): he distanced him, killed him {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means enmity and distance, and to weaken something such that it becomes brittle.

“اَسْحَقَ الضَّرْعُ” (*as-haqaz zar-u*): the nipples became dried of milk and withered.

This is done so that man should gain knowledge about those things and make use of them. As such, the nation which deliberates upon them and utilizes them will be the nation which makes the right use of the creation.

We should reflect in the revelation by the Quran which has revolutionized human thinking. Man used to be afraid of the forces of nature, he used to worship them, used to plead before them, or think that he was weak and powerless before them. The Quran said that this was a false concept. Every force in the universe is subservient to man. These forces do not have control him and are to be brought under his control and used for the benefit of the mankind. The ‘*malaikah*’ or the forces of nature are subservient to man. This raised man’s status above everything in the universe and the door to understanding and exploring the universe was thus opened. Any nation that acquires knowledge of the laws of nature will make these forces to come under their control and can take advantage of these resources. In this respect there is no differentiation between a *kafir* and a *momin*. Although a *kaafir* would use these forces of nature for own good, while a *momin* will use them for the overall good of mankind. This shows that man’s status demands that he conquers the forces of nature and make use of them according to his will.

The status of a *momin* is that he conquers the forces of nature and utilizes them for the benefit of mankind as directed and explained in the Quran. He who does not conquer these forces in the first place, leaving the status of a *momin* aside, does not even deserve the status of a human being.

“سَخِرَ” (*sakhira*) in the meaning of jest and satire has appeared at several places in the Quran as in 49:11, 37:12 and 21:41. Surah *Al-Momin* says “سَخِرِيَّاءُ” (*sikhriyya*) in 23:110 which means the explained earlier.

S-Kh-Te س خ ط

“السُّخْطُ” (*assukht*), “السَّخَطُ” (*as-sakhat*): dislike, hatred, unwillingness, anger.

“سَخِطَ عَلَيْهِ” (*sakhita alaih*): he was angry at him.

“سَخِطَ” (*sakhit*): he disliked it, hated it.

“أَسَخَطَهُ” (*askhatah*): he annoyed him, made him angry.

“الْمَسْخُوطُ” (*al-maskhuut*): hateful, disliked {T}.

Raghib says “سَخَطُ” (*sakhat*) means extreme anger which demands punishment {R}.

But when this word is attributed to God, it will not have this meaning because God is high above such human emotions as anger. It becomes clear as noted in Surah *Muhammed*:

47:28	There is adversity for them because they do not follow Allah’s guidance; they dislike things which are according to Allah’s directions.	ذَٰلِكَ بِأَنَّهُمْ اتَّبَعُوا مَا أَصْخَطَ اللَّهُ وَكَرِهُوا رِضْوَانَهُ فَأَحْبَطَ أَعْمَالَهُمْ
47:26	They dislike the revelation: this results in their deeds going wasted i.e. without results	كَرِهُوا رِضْوَانَهُ يَعْنِي كَرِهُوا مَا نَزَّلَ اللَّهُ

That is, they do not produce the good results that they are expecting. As such “مَا أَصْخَطَ اللَّهُ” (*ma askhat allah*) means those things which are not according to Allah’s laws and which result in their deeds being unproductive. There is no meaning of anger here. In 3:161, “سَخَطُ” (*sakhat*) has come opposite to “رِضْوَانُ” (*rizwaan*).

Surah *Al-Ma’idah* says “أَنْ سَخِطَ اللَّهُ” (*un sakhitallahu*) which has been explained by “مَا قَدَّمْتُ لَهُمْ أَنْفُسَهُمْ” (*qaddamat lahum anfusahum*) in 5:80, which means the “natural outcome of ones actions”.

For more details see heading (R-Zd-Y) and (Gh-Zd-B).

“السَّدَّ” (*as-sud*): obstruction, barrier, mountain. Some say “السَّدَّ” (*as-sid*) is an obstruction that is manmade, and “السَّدَّ” (*as-sodd*) means a natural obstruction like a mountain {T}, but others do not agree with this differentiation. In the Quran “السَّدَّ” (*as-sudd*) has been used in meaning mountain (18:93) as well as for a man made obstruction (18:94). Surah *Yasin* uses this word to mean such causes and effects which obstruct human intellect and comprehension (36:9).

Ibn Faris thinks the basic meanings are to fill some gap and make it smooth.

“سَدَّدَ الرُّمَحَ” (*saddadar rumh*): straightened or corrected the (bent) spear.

“سَدَّدَ النَّفْسَ” (*saddadas salam*): filled the gap {T}.

“رَجُلٌ سَدِيدٌ” (*rajulun sadeed*): a man who takes the right path.

“أَمْرٌ سَدِيدٌ” (*amrun sadeed*): something that fills every gap there may be in the truth.

Raghib says it means balanced and moderate talk which includes no exaggeration whatsoever.

The Quran says:

4:9	very balanced, and straightforward and clear	قَوْلًا سَدِيدًا
33:70	talk, which leaves no doubt	

It is the Quranic teaching to be clear, straight, honest and truthful in dealing with others and talk without ambiguity, straight forwardly, and in a balanced manner. One should adopt a speech which is direct and to the point. It must not be meaningless and pointless.

“سَهْمٌ سَدِيدٌ” (*sahmun sadeeda*) is an arrow which finds the target straight away {R}.

Diplomacy is against the teachings of the Quran: See heading *radam* for the difference between “سَدَّ” (*sudd*) and “رَدَّمَ” (*radam*).

“السِّدْرُ” (*as-sidr*): a lote tree. The singular is “سِدْرَةٌ” (*sidrah*). A lotetree has a good shade when it is in full blossom and when the Arabs are very tired from the heat of the desert, they rest under it. Therefore it symbolizes a heavenly place {R}. “فِي سِدْرٍ مَّخْضُودٍ” (*fi sidrim makhzood*) is a tree which is laden with fruit and which has a good shade (56:28), or trees which have good shades but no needles to contend with. That is, comfort without any qualms.

In meaning of shade, this word appears at another place:

4:57	And We will admit them to thick shades	وَنُدْخِلُهُمْ ظِلًّا ظَلِيلًا
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Here comfort and wellbeing both are implied. This tree is evergreen even in the desert climate, but according to *Raghib*, though its fruit is not great in nutrients, but its shade is. The Quran says that when the *saba* area became barren after the floods, then some lote trees grew there in place of the very lush gardens.

34:16	And something of few plum trees	وَشَيْءٌ مِّنْ سِدْرٍ قَلِيلٍ
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“سَدِيرُ النَّخْلِ” (*sadeerun nakhl*) means clump of date palms {T}.

“سَدِرَ” (*saadir*): he was surprised, he couldn't see due to intense heat.

“السَّادِرُ” (*as-saadir*): a man who is mesmerised due to the intensity of the heat.

“سَدِرَ بَصْرُهُ سَدْرًا” (*sadira basarahu sadara*): due to the intensity of the heat, his eyes opened wide with wonderment {R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means surprise and bewilderment.

“السَّادِرُ” (*as-saadior*): means one who is surprised.

Surah *An-Najam* describes the status of messenger-hood in a symbolic way. Note that the condition of revelation can only be related in a symbolic way because nobody except a messenger can ever understand the true state of it, although one can understand what is meant. It has been said that the place from where a messenger gets the revelation, the human intellect can only be surprised at it. Human intellect cannot understand what that state is.

The Quran says:

53:14	The state where there is abundant surprise	عِنْدَ سِدْرَةِ الْمُنْتَهَى
53:16	when that which overshadows was overshadowing	إِذْ يَغْشَى السَّدْرَةَ مَا يَغْشَى

Other than the messenger of Allah none can understand what the state was. For the eyes it was profound bewilderment like the expanse of the heated sand of the desert with mirages all around but despite that:

53:17	the eye of the messenger did not take for a deception, it observed the truth as a clear reality and with no ambiguity.	مَا زَاغَ الْبَصَرُ وَمَا طَغَى
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But this only implies for those realities which are manifested before him, it cannot cross the limit set for him because the revelation does not come to him by personal effort, so it did not increase with his efforts. Truth is revealed to him i.e. only the part which is meant to be disclosed. As compared to ordinary human beings, a messenger's knowledge knows no bounds, but compared to God's knowledge, it has limits and it cannot go beyond those limits.

Raghib says that verse 53:16 points to the place or the same tree under which the messenger (*pbuh*) made the pact with God (48:18), but obviously here the word has more of a connotation of the state than meant to be some geographical location.

“السَّادِرُ” (*as-sadder*): a fountainhead or reservoir of water, or river {T}.

“السَّدرُ” (*as-sidr*): sea. It can also mean the fountainhead of God.

“سِدْرَةُ الْمُنْتَهَى” (*sidratul muntaha*): the source of revelation where there is utter surprise for human intellect, but the messenger's eye sees it clearly.

S-D-S

س د س

“السُّدُسُ” (*as-suds*), “السُّدُسُ” (*as-sudus*): sixth part (4:11).

“السَّيْتُ” (*as-siit*): it was actually “سِدْسُ” (*sids*) which later turned to “سَيْدْتُ” (*as-siit*), i.e. six.

“سِتُونٌ” (*sittuun*), “سِتِينَ” (*sittiin*): sixty {T} (58:2).

“سَادِسٌ” (*saadisun*): sixth (18:22).

Also see heading (S-T-T).

“السَّدى” (*as-sada*): warp of the cloth.

“قَدْ أَسَدَى النَّوْبَ” (*qud asdayas saub*) and “سَدَّاهُ” (*saddah*): he straightened the warp of the cloth.

“السُّدى” (*assudya*): camels which are left to roam on their own {T}.

“ذَهَبَ كَلَامُهُ سَدَى” (*zaraba kal-uhi sudya*): his talk went waste {M}.

Ibn Faris says that “سدى” (*sudyah*) means to leave something roam free and at its own.

Khalil says “سَدْوَن” (*sadwun*) is a child’s game which is played with marbles and walnuts, in which they throw these things with their hands.

The Quran says:

75:36	Does man think that he will be left unaccountable	أَلَيْسَ الْإِنْسَانُ أَنْ يُتْرَكَ سُدًى
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This meaning of this root needs careful attention. For weaving cloth, warp and weft both are required. Even if the warp is a hundred yards long, it is useless alone until it has weft, we cannot weave cloth without either one. Whatever social system man established was either like warp alone or weft alone. Sometimes he sought spiritualism and at other times he became completely materialistic. He has tried to keep the permanent values away from his political world. This is the reason his efforts to establish a system which can provide development of the self and prepare him for a higher purpose of life, have mostly evaded him. Humans either remained like warp or like weft but never became whole like cloth. The Quran declared that it is wrong for man to be either one entirely. He also needs the other part, but for this he will have to realize that his life has a great purpose before him. He is accountable for whatever he does in this life and his life in the hereafter will be based on his conduct here. Therefore the in this life he should use the right type of warp and weft to weave a cloth which fits into the design proposed by the Quran. This is called the righteous path. The human intellect alone cannot guide in this life as human beings do not have any internal guidance. The human intellect produces good results only when it works under the guidance provided by the divine revelation now preserved in the Quran.

Now consider the other meaning i.e. to let the camels go without someone to guide them. Allah has not left man rudderless in this way, but has provided guidance through the revelation. Therefore the correct option for man is to follow the guidance path defined and explained in the revelation i.e. the Quran. If he does not follow it, then all his efforts will go waste as noted and explained in the Quran (18:103-106). In the universe, except man, all other creations are bound to follow Allah’s guidance which is inbuilt. They cannot do otherwise. This is what is called their nature (or instincts). God has formulated laws for human beings too but has given him the power to decide whether to follow them or not to follow them. However, he does not have the power to alter the effects of following the chosen path. He has the option to ignore Allah’s laws but the results will definitely be compiled as per these laws. This is called the Law of Requital.

“السَّرْبُ” (*as-sarb*): a camel, or grazing cattle.

“السَّرِبُ” (*as-sarib*): flowing water.

“السَّرْبَةُ” (*as-surbah*): path, road.

“السَّارِبُ” (*as-saarib*): to roam in the land without any restriction and at will {T, R}.

“السَّرَبُ” (*as-sarab*) and “السَّرِبُ” (*as-sarib*) means water that flows out of the leather containers.

Surah *Ar-Raad* says:

13:10	One who walks or moves by the day {T, R}.	سَارِبٌ بِالنَّهَارِ
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Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:62	This fish made its way in the river.	فَأَتَّخَذَ سَبِيلَهُ فِي الْبَحْرِ سَرَبًا
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This word connotes moving about without restriction and with complete freedom.

Azhari has said that “سَرَبَتِ الْإِبِلُ” (*sarbatil ilibil*) is for camels to go freely where ever they may desire {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says that this root has the meaning of expanse and to move on the earth.

Raghib says it means water that leaks.

“سَرَابٌ” (*saraab*): mirage.

The Quran has likened the wrong path to a mirage (24:39). Living life without guidance is likened to looking for water by chasing a mirage which is deceptive and unreal. Our desires and deeds may look very attractive but bear on long lasting effects in life and like chasing a mirage the life ends wasted without any purpose. The Quran calls such a life as a path which leads to self-destruction.

Raghib says “السَّرَابُ” (*as-sarb*) means to go towards the low lying areas or slope, because the water flows towards the slope – freedom to flow is evident in this meaning. Low lying area.

S-R-B-L س ر ب ل

“سِرْبَالٌ” (*sirbal*), with its plural “سَرَابِيلٌ” (*sarabeel*) means shirts, or armour, or any dress that is worn on the upper part of the body like a shirt {T, M}. The Quran has used this word in both meanings.

16:81	He created your dress which protects you from the heat and created the armour which protects you in war	وَجَعَلَ لَكُمْ سَرَابِيلَ تَقِيكُمُ الْحَرَّ وَسَرَابِيلَ تَقِيكُمُ بَأْسَكُمْ
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In surah *Ibrahim*, it is said about rebels of Islam that when their strength breaks:

14:50	their armour will turn to coal tar	سَرَابِيلُهُمْ مِنْ قَطِرَانٍ
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This means that their armour which protects them from the enemy, will stick to their bodies like coaltar instead of providing protection.

S-R-J س ر ج

“السِّرَاجُ” (*as-siraaaj*) means a lamp or anything which gives out light {T, R}. Some think that it is the Arabized version of Persian word “چراغ” (*chiraagh*) which means a lamp.

“السِّرَاجُ” (*as-siraaaj*) also means the sun {T, R}.

The Quran has said:

25:61	And made in it the sun	جَعَلَ فِيهَا سِرَاجًا
71:16	The sun was made a lamp (to provide light)	وَجَعَلَ الشَّمْسُ سِرَاجًا

The Messenger (*pbuh*) has been called “سِرَاجًا مُنِيرًا” (*siraaajaw muneera*) in 33:46.

“السَّرْجُ” (*as-sarj*): saddle.

“السَّرَّاجُ” (*as-saraaj*): saddle maker, one who tells a lot of lies {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says that this root basically means beauty, adornment, and good looks.

The lamp is called “السَّرَّاجُ” (*as-siraaj*) because of its light’s beauty. A saddle is called “السَّرْجُ” (*as-siraaj*) because it adorns an animal. “سَرَّجَ وَجْهَهُ” (*sarraja wajhahu*): he adorned his face, made it more beautiful.

S-R-H

س ر ح

“السَّرْحُ” (*as-sarh*), “التَّسْرِيحُ” (*as-saareeh*): to let animals graze freely in a pasture in the morning {T}.

16:6	When you take them out for grazing	حِينَ تَسْرَحُونَ
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“سَرَّاحٌ” (*sarah*) and “تَسْرِيحٌ” (*tasreeh*) mean to let free or to liberate from a contract like wedlock. Hence it may be used for divorce and to liberate {T}.

33:28	And to set you free (let you go) in a good manner	وَأُسْرَحُكُمْ سَرَاحًا جَمِيلًا
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This word has appeared against “إِمْسَاكٌ” (*imsaak*) which means to block in surah *Al-Baqrah*:

2:229- 2:231	To keep obligated under contract	فَأَمْسَاكٌ بِمَعْرُوفٍ أَوْ تَسْرِيحٌ بِإِحْسَانٍ
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Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to open up or to proceed to go.

S-R-D

س ر د

Ibn Faris says that “السَّرْدُ” (*as-sard*) means to join one thing with another, like the links in armour.

It is also used to mean making armour and for sewing shoes or other leather goods.

“السَّرْدُ” (*as-sard*): hole.

“الْمِسْرَدُ” (*al-misrud*): that with which a hole is made.

“السَّرِيدَةُ” (*as-sareedah*): leather string with which shoe etc. is sewn {T}.

The Quran says:

34:11	keep measure of the holes correctly so that the links of the armour may fit into them	وَقَدَرْنِي السَّرْدَ
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The second part of the verse refers to righteous deeds implying that these deeds tie together just like armour and provide protection in the long run.

S-R-D-Q

س ر د ق

“السَّرَادِقُ” (*as-suraadiq*): that covering (of canvas or cloth) which is strung over the house patio, or any wall, or canvas wall which is strung or built around something. That is why it also means the cloud which spreads around a place and encircles it {T}.

Ibn Faris says “السَّرَادِقُ” (*as-suraadiq*) means dust cloud.

Raghib says it is a Persian word that has been adopted in Arabic {R}.

The Quran says:

18:29	The fire of hell whose columns will surround them from all sides. (i.e. Hell will encompass them from all sides)	نَارًا أَحَاطَ بِهِمْ سُرَادِقُهَا
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“السِّرُّ” (*as-sirruh*): that matter which is kept secret {T}.

This root means to hide, but sometimes it also means the opposite i.e. to reveal {Latif-ul-Lugha} {F}. “السُّرُورُ” (*as-sururu*), “الْحُبُورُ” (*hubur*) and “الْفَرَحُ” (*al-farah*) are almost similar words but “السُّرُورُ” (*as-surur*) is the happiness which remains in the heart and “الْحُبُورُ” (*hubur*) is the happiness which gets reflected through one’s face. These are both good traits but “فَرَحٌ” (*farah*) is that happiness which produces false pride, and hence is bad {M}.

“سَرَّهَ” (*sarrah*): made him happy.

“مَسْرُورٌ” (*masroor*): happy (84:9-13).

“السِّرُّ” (*as-siir*): the beginning of anything, it’s pure or basic part, the core. It is also used for prime land.

“سَرَارَةُ الْوَادِي” (*sararatul waadi*): the best part of the valley.

“الْمَسَرَّةُ” (*al-masarrah*): throne of flowers.

“السَّرَّاءُ” (*as-sarra’a*): well being, abundance of prosperity, comfort and luxury {T}.

This word is the opposite of “الضَّرَّاءُ” (*azzarra’a*) in 7:95.

“السُّرِّيَّةُ” (*as-suriyyah*): a slave girl with whom sexual relations were established.

“السَّرِيرُ” (*as-sareer*): government, seat of government, seat, bed {T}, because only well established people have it.

Surah *An-Anaam* has used “سِرٌّ” (*sirrun*) opposite to “جَهْرٌ” (*jahr*) in 6:3. As such, “سِرٌّ” (*sirrun*) means secrets.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* has used words like “مَاسِيْرُونَ” (*mayusirron*) and “مَا يُعْلِنُونَ” (*mayo’linun*) to mean secret talks in 2:77.

Surah *Ibrahim* says:

14:31	Whatever Allah has given them, whether unseen qualities or things of this world which one can see, are kept available for the benefit of mankind	وَيُنْفِقُوْا مِمَّا رَزَقْنَاهُمْ سِرًّا وَعَلَانِيَةً
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It could also mean openly and secretly.

In Surah *Taha* it says:

20:7	He knows secrets and even more hidden things.	يَعْلَمُ السِّرَّ وَأَخْفَى
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Surah *Yunus* says:

10:54	They will try to hide their shame when they meet the punishment.	وَأَسْرَوْا الصَّامِتَ
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Some scholars say that this word means opposite of hiding, that is, to reveal, but hiding seems more appropriate here.

“سُرُرٌ” (*surur*) means wooden short seat (15:47). Singular is “سَرِيرٌ” (*sareer*), and “سَرَّاءٌ” (*saraa-ir*) means secret talks (86:9). Singular is “سَرِيرٌ” (*sareer*).

“إِسْرَارٌ” (*israar*) means to talk about secret things, to hide from others and talk secretly (27:26).

“السَّرْعُ” (*as-sara’a*), “السَّريْعُ” (*as-sari’h*), “السُّرْعَةُ” (*as-sur’ah*): to become fast, to happen quickly, fastness, haste.

“سَرْعٌ” (*saru’h*): fast wind, he hurried.

“السَّرْعَانُ مِنَ الْخَيْلِ” (*as-sar’aanu minal kail*): horses which surge ahead {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to make haste.

The Quran has said at various places:

2:202	Allah is quick in accountability	اللَّهُ سَرِيعُ الْحِسَابِ
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According to the Law of Requitall every cause has an effect. However, the results take time to materialise though the natural turn of events starts long before the result becomes evident. For example a plant starts its growth the moment a seed is planted in the ground and right environment is provided to the seed. However, the growth manifests itself after sometime when it erupts from the ground and one can see the branches and the stem of the plant. Likewise a our deeds start formulating results when the action is taken, but the consequence is manifested sometime later. This is how the turn of events is “سَرِيعُ الْحِسَابِ” (*saree-ul hisaab*), or quick in holding accountability. The Quran has declared that every deed is accountable (45:21).

Surah *Al-Qaf* mentione “سِرَاعًا” (*sira’un*) which means something that happens quickly.

“سَارِعًا” (*saara’a*), “مُسَارِعَةً” (*musara’ah*) and “سِرَاعًا” (*sira’an*) mean to make haste, to compete.

“وَسَارِعُوا إِلَىٰ مَغْفِرَةٍ” (*saari-u ila maghfirah*): make haste in going towards security (3:132).

“السَّرْفُ” (*as-surf*): to cross the limit, to commit an excess {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to do something foolish.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:33	He should not exceed in killing	فَلَا يَسْرِفْ فِي الْقَتْلِ
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This means that he should remain within limits, lest he kills the killer himself, by taking the law into his own hands in foolishness. In this case one should hand over the matter over to a court of law. This is explained further by “إِنَّهُ كَانَ مُنْصَوِّرًا” (*innakana mansora*):

Surah *Al-Furqaan* uses this word against “قَتَرَ” (*qatar*) in 25:67. “قَتَرَ” (*qatar*) means miserliness and constriction. As such “إِسْرَافٌ” (*israaf*) would be “إِفْرَاطٌ” (*ifraat*) against “تَفْرِيطٌ” (*tafreet*). That is, to spend more than necessary at a place i.e. to waste.

That is why it is said:

	The mother fed too much milk to her child and spoiled his health	سَرَفَتِ الْأُمُّ وَلَدَهَا
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This means for a thing to go waste because the intended benefit does not accrue.

“سَرَفُ الْمَاءِ” (*saraful ma’i*) means water to be wasted by giving no benefit when it flows across the floor {T}. That is why not keeping a thing where it is meant to be kept is called “إِسْرَافٌ” (*israaf*), and one who does so is called “مُسْرِفٌ” (*musrif*). The nation of *Loot* is called “قَوْمٌ مُسْرِفُونَ” (*qaumun musrifoon*) in 7:81,

because they used to waste their reproductive ability by resorting to sexual perversion. The Quran warns us that these practices may not be taken serious when become prevalent; however, these have serious long term consequences in the life of nations and lead to their ultimate fall. Those who create chaos in the land are also called “مُسْرِفِينَ” (*musrifeen*) as in (26:151).

The above explanations show that “إِسْرَافٌ” (*israaf*) is not only being a wasteful spender (or one who spends needlessly), it also means to spend human energy, time, wealth or any other capability for a purpose which is not constructive, or to waste it for destructive results.

For the difference between “إِسْرَافٌ” (*israaf*) and “تَبْذِيرٌ” (*tabzeer*) see heading (B-Dh-R).

S-R-Q

س ر ق

“سَرَقَ” (*saariqah*): to take someone else’s possession secretly. If it is taken openly, then this act will be called “إِخْتِلَاسٌ” (*ikhhtilaas*), “إِسْتِلَابٌ إِنْتِهَابٌ” (*istilaab intihaab*) if the owner resists. But if it is still taken from him by force then it will be called “غَصَبٌ” (*ghasab*) {T, M}.

“سَرَقَ الشَّيْءُ” (*sariqas shaiyi*): the thing became hidden.

“هُوَ يَسَارِقُ النَّظَرَ إِلَيْهِ” (*huwa yusaariqun nazara ilaih*): he is looking as glance at him.

“إِنْسَرَقَ عَنْهُمْ” (*insaraqa unhum*): to slip away quietly {T, M}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:81	Your son has stolen	إِنَّ ابْنَكَ سَرَقَ
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“السَّارِقُ” (*as-saariq*): thief (5:38).

“إِسْتَرْقَ السَّمْعَ” (*istaraqas sam’a*): to eavesdrop {T, M} (15:18).

In 37:10 it has been said “خَطَفَ الْخَطْفَةَ” (*ikhifatil khatfitah*): to catch something in the air, or to get the whiff of something and to build mountain out of molehill.

For the punishment for a thief is “قَطَعَ يَدَ” (*qataa yud*) as noted in (5:38) i.e. cutting hands. For details of this, see heading (Q-Te-Ain).

S-R-M-D

س ر م د

“السَّرْمَدُ” (*as-sarmad*): permanent, a thing which always remains and which never ends.

“لَيْلٌ سَرْمَدٌ” (*lailun sarmad*): long night.

Raazi says “سَرْمَدٌ” (*sarmad*) has been culled from “سَرْدٌ” (*sard*) which means continuous and one after another. By adding “م” (*miim*) to it, the benefit of exaggeration has been obtained, thus it would mean continuous period {T, R}. *Ibn Faris* says this as well.

Muheet says that “السَّرْمَدِيُّ” (*assarmadi*) is something which has no beginning or end {M}.

The Quran says:

28:71	If Allah prolongs the night for you {T, R}.	إِنْ جَعَلَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْكُمُ اللَّيْلَ سَرْمَدًا
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“السُّرَى” (*as-sura*): to walk the better part of the night.
 “سَرَى” (*sara*), “يَسْرَى” (*yasri*), “سُرَى” (*surya*): to walk at night.
 “أَسْرَى إِسْرَاءً” (*asrya isra'*): to walk during the night.
 “السَّرِيَّةُ” (*as-sarriyyah*): an army contingent, because it moves at night so that the enemy is not warned.
 “السَّرِيَّةُ” (*as-sariyyo*): small canal which goes towards an oasis {M}.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:24	there is a canal, down the slope	تَحْتَكِ سَرِيًّا
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“سَرَاةً” (*sarah*): the higher part of something, vast expanse of land.

Raghib and *Muheet* say that in 17:1, when it says “سُبْحَنَ الَّذِي أَسْرَى بِعَبْدِهِ” (*subhaanal lazi asra bi-abdehi*), the word “السُّرَى” (*asra*) has not come from “سَرَى يَسْرَى” (*sarah yasri*) which means to walk at night, but rather from “سَرَاةً” (*sarah*), which means that God took his missionary to “سَرَاةً” (*sarah*), vast expanse of land.

“أَجْبَلًا” (*ajbala*) means that he went atop a mountain and “أَثَمًا” (*athama*) means that he went to the “تِهَامَةَ” (*tahamah*) {R, M}. Mecca had become a restricted land for the Messenger (*pbuh*) and his companions, so he migrated to Medina where the atmosphere for his mission was more favourable and there were more opportunities for his work.

But we consider that this “سَرَى” (*sarya*) is indeed from “يَسْرَى” (*yasri*) and *lilan* is an addition for stress. History tells us that the Messenger (*pbuh*) had commenced his migration journey at night.

Ibn Faris says it means physical courage and generosity and the word is spelled both as (S-R-Y) and (S.R-W).

Hence “السَّرَوُ” (*assaro*) means to open something up
 “سَرَاةُ النَّهَارِ” (*saratun nahaar*): the peak of a day.

“السَّطْحُ” (*as-sath*): the roof of a house which is even/flat (smooth), or the upper part of anything.
 “سَطَحَ” (*satash*), “يَسْطَحُ” (*yastah*): he spread out, smoothened it and laid out.
 “الْمَسْطَحُ” (*al-mastah*): smooth place where dates are dried {T, R}.

The Quran says:

88:20	(don't you notice) at the earth, how it is spread out (for habitation)	وَالْيَ الْأَرْضِ كَيْفَ سُطِحَتْ
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“سَطَرَ” (*satar*), “يَسْطُرُ” (*yastur*), “سَطْرًا” (*satra*): to write (in straight lines).

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to make even rows, like the lines in a book or a row of trees. This has led it to mean writing.

68:1	By the ink pot and the pen, and what ever they write	ن وَالْقَلَمِ وَمَا يَسْطُرُونَ
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This above verse is referring to the Quran and all the knowledge which man puts down in writing for safe keeping. All testify to this fact.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:58	that which is written in the book	كَانَ ذَلِكَ فِي الْكِتَابِ مَسْطُورًا
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“مَعْنَى مُسْتَطَرٍّ” (*mustatar*) has the same meaning as mentioned above (54:53).

“الْأَسَاطِيرُ” (*al-asaateer*) is the plural of “أَسْطُورَةٌ” (*oosturah*), which means stories, tales. {T}.

Some have said that word means a story. The Quran says that when these people are told to deliberate on historical facts to find out what happened to the nations which indulged in what you too are practicing, they reply by saying:

6:25	These are tales from the past, which we have nothing to do with us	إِنْ هَذَا إِلَّا آسَاطِيرُ الْأَوَّلِينَ
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The Quran states that previous generations were warned that early nations got destroyed according to the Law of Requit and that the present generations will also experience the same outcome if their conduct remains the same.. The present day Muslims who read the Quran have the same attitude as those of the previous generations. When they are warned about the Law of Requit and what it did to the previous nations, they say that it was applicable to the Jews, or it was concerning the Christians, or this is about the pagans (*mushrikeen*) of Mecca, or this is about the hypocrites of Medina. In other words the entire Quran is only narrating the tales from the past which has no implications for the modern world. The present day Muslims claim that the only part that is relevant for us is, where there is a mention of the promises of paradise and heavenly life. The Quran states that this is their false claim and complacency and has nothing to do with the accountability process. Each individual is accountable for his deed (45:21). Since stories and tales are generally made up, “سَطَرٌ” (*sattara*), “تَسْطِيرًا” (*tasteera*) means to collect lies {T}, and since “سَطَرٌ” (*satrun*) means a straight line, therefore “السَّطْرُ” (*as-satr*) also means to cut straight with the sword.

“السَّاطُورُ” (*as-saatoor*) means knife {T}.

“سَيَطِرَ عَلَيْهِ” (*sversera alaih*): to stand straight as a row at someone’s head.

This led it to mean “الْمُسَيطِرُ” (*al-musatr*) which means overseer, guard, imposer {R}.

The Quran says:

88:22	You are not a guardian over them	لَسْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ مُنْصِفٌ
52:37	Are they imposed ones?	أَمْ هُمْ الْمُنْصِفُونَ

In these verses the meanings are equivalent with “مَسْطُورُونَ” (*masallatoon*) which means those who are imposed as guards on someone

S-Te-W س ط و

“سَطَا عَلَيْهِ وَبِهِ” (*sata alihi wabehi*), “سَطَوَا” (*satwun*), “سَطَوْه” (*satwah*): to attack or to strongly overpower someone.

Raghib says to attack someone physically with bare hands is called “سَطَوْه” (*satwah*). Actually it is derived from “سَطَا الْفَرَسُ” (*satal faras*) which means a horse to raise its forelegs and stand on its hind legs {T, R}.

The Quran says:

22:72	they might attack any moment (commit excesses on them)	يَكَاذِبُونَ يَسْطُونَ
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Ibn Faris says it basically means anger and overpowering, as well as height.

“سَطَا الْمَاءُ” (*satal ma-o*): water level has increased many folds.

“سَعَدَهُ اللَّهُ” (*sa’adahul-lah*): Allah helped him
 “يَسْعُدُهُ” (*yas-aduhu*), “سَعَدًا” (*sa’da*): he guided him.
 “سَعِيدٌ” (*sa’id*), “يَسْعُدُ” (*yas’ud*), “سَعْدًا” (*sa’da*), “سَعَادَةً” (*sa’adah*): he was blessed.
 “الْإِسْعَادُ” (*al-eesaad*), “الْمُسَاعَدَةُ” (*al-musa’adah*): to help.

Faraa says it means to follow Allah’s guidance and His commandments.

“السَّاعِدُ” (*as-sa’id*): the part of the hand from the elbow to the wrist wherein all the strength lies.
 This led to “الْمُسَاعَدَةُ” (*al-musa’idah*) meaning to help one another, that is because when people go on a mission to help one another, they walk hand in hand as close companions {T, R}.

The Quran quotes “سَعِدٌ” (*saeedun*) which has appeared opposite to “شَقِيٌّ” (*shaqiyun*) in (11:105) The later means going against Allah’s guidance.

“شَقِيٌّ” (*shaqiyun*) too has come against “سَعِيدٌ” (*saeedun*) in (11:106-108). That is, fortunate is he who is close to Allah by opting to follow His guidance to go forward in life, and while “شَقِيٌّ” (*shaqiyun*) is he who ignores this guidance and thus remains deprived of its benefits. It is an unimaginable personal loss for those who reject the guidance of Allah as revealed and preserved in the Quran.

Raghib says “السَّعْدُ” (*assa’du*) and “السَّعَادَةُ” (*as-sa’adatah*) refers to the help which comes from Allah to those who opt to follow the guidance to help them reach virtue. We sometime hear people saying that such a thing is “سَعِدٌ” (*sa’d*) lucky or such a thing is “نَحْسٌ” (*nahas*) unlucky. Similarly this day is “سَعِدٌ” (*sa’ad*) lucky or so and so day “نَحْسٌ” (*nahas*) is unlucky. This is all non sense and the Quran warns us to stay from all such beliefs as these keep us away from the righteous path.

Nothing is lucky or unlucky. Any deed which has good result according to the criterion from the Quran is good and can be called “سَعِدٌ” (*sa’ad*), and the day on which the result appears can be called “مَسْعُودٌ” (*masood*). Likewise, any deed whose result is bad using the Quranic criterion is called “نَحْسٌ” (*nahas*) and the day on which this result appears can be called “مَنْحُوسٌ” (*manhoos*). The days of the week have no significance at their own since these are simply measurements of time fixed by us to be aware of the passing time (and life). There is nothing “سَعِدٌ” (*sa’ad*) or “نَحْسٌ” (*nahas*) in the stars either. Stars follow their designed paths according to the known laws and the Quran makes it very clear. These have absolutely no connection to anyone’s fate. Our fate is in our own hand and this is dependent on our deeds. More details can be found under the heading (N-H-Sd).

“السُّعْرُ” (*as-so’ar*): the heat of the fire, hunger.

Ibn A’rfa says that “سُعْرٌ” (*so’ar*) means something that burns someone.

Faraa says it means to bother, hard work, severe pain, hardship.

“سَعَرْنَاَهُم بِالنَّبْلِ” (*sa’rna hum bin nabl*): we shot arrows at them and pierced them {T}.
 “مَسْعُورٌ” (*mas’or*) means a man who is very thirsty and hungry {T}. Also one who is greedy for more even though he has had his fill or one whose desire is never satisfied {M}.
 “السُّعَارُ” (*as-su’ar*): the heat of the fire, or intense hunger.
 “السَّعَارُ” (*as-sa’er*): fire, flaming fire {T}.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:10	Those who unjustly usurp the orphan's possessions, fill themselves with fire and they will be thrust into flaming fire	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَأْكُلُونَ أَمْوَالَ الْيَتَامَى ظُلْمًا إِنَّمَا يَأْكُلُونَ فِي بُطُونِهِمْ نَارًا - وَيَصْعَلُونَ سَعِيرًا
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What will happen to such people after death is to be seen over there (in the world hereafter). In this life such people are extremely greedy with unsatiable greed for riches, and they madly pursue easy money.. As such, “سَعَرٌ” (*sa’ar*) and “سَعَرٌ” (so’or) means madness as well {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for something to flare up, to be raised, to be provoked.

“سَعَرَ” (*sa’ar*) and “سَعَرَ النَّارَ وَالْحَرْبَ” (*sa’aran naar wal hurb*) would mean to intensify the battle and make it rage {T}.

81:12	and when hell will be stoked	وَ إِذَا الْجُحِيمُ سُعِرَتْ
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This indicates the intensity of the punishment which will be intense according to severity of the committed crime.

S-Ain-Y س ع ي

“سَعَى” (*sayun*) means to intend, to walk fast or move fast, to arrange for something, or struggle for it.

Muheet says that when this word is used to mean go or run, it is followed by “إِلَى” (*ila*), like in “فَاسْعُوا إِلَى” (*fas-au ila zikril lah*), and when it is used to mean struggle or strive for, then it is followed by “لِ” (*laam*), like in “سَعَى لَهَا السَّاعَى” (*as-sa’aa laha*)

“سَعَى” (*as saee*) one who tries, also one who collects charitable donations .

The Quran has used this word to mean run (2:260, 20:20), as well as to mean to strive (17:19). That is, running around, struggle, strive and take action, etc.

The Quran says:

53:39	a man gets what he strives for	لَيْسَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ إِلَّا مَا سَعَى
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This verse guides to a great principle. Economics also dictates that man should only receive the remuneration for his labour. To take something for nothing or to receive the returns on capital is not legitimate as one has not worked for it. The benefits of a system which is built upon this principle can only be imagined by those who have insight. This principle highlights the fact that a man's place in society is determined by the labour he puts in, and not by virtue of his family or other references.

In the world of Deen this principle establishes the fact that deliverance and happiness accrue only through one's own efforts and not by someone's recommendation or favour.

The Quran has also refuted the concept that every child is born with the sins of his parents. Quran refutes that he is atoning for the sins committed during his last incarnation. A human being is born with a clean slate, and he becomes liable to get as many pleasures of life as he struggles for doing good deeds. This principle also announces to the world of statesmanship and politics that every human child must get a level playing field. Nobody should be favoured in this respect nor obstructed. Is this not a revolutionary idea as a Quranic Principle to be put forward to the modern world?

“سَغَبٌ” (*saghab*), “يَسْغَبُ” (*yasghab*), “وَسْغَبُ” (*saghebu*), “يَسْغَبُ” (*yasghab*), “سَغْبًا” (*saghaba*), “مَسْغَبَةً” (*musghaba*): to be tired and hungry.

Raghib says it also means to be thirsty.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is hunger.

“الْمَسْغَبَةُ” (*al-masghabah*) means drought.

The Quran says:

90:14	Arrange for food of people when hunger and strife is all around	إِطْعَامٌ فِي يَوْمٍ مَسْغَبَةٍ
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The Quran has compared it to climbing uphill (90:11-14). To earn with one's own efforts and to spend whatever more one earns which exceed his needs at a time when hunger is galore, is a great thing to do. This is what polishes human personality, and this is what Islam aims at. This is what is meant by establishing a system of 'raboobiyat' or welfare. In this connection, these verses of surah *Al-Balad* are a great manifestation of truth (90:11-16), and they should be studied in detail as a permanent value. Details can be found in the book titled Islamic System of Sustenance by *G.A.Parwez*.

“سَفَحَ الدَّمَ” (*safahad-dum*): he let blood flow, dropped blood, killed

“سَفَحَ الدَّمَعَ” (*safahad dum-a*): he shed tears

“سَفَحَ الدَّمَعَ” (*safahad dum-u*): tears rolled down

“الْمُسَافَحَةُ” (*al-musafaha*): to fornicate, because in it the human effort is wasted without any commitment.

Thus in the pre-Islamic era of ignorance when Arabs invited a woman for marriage, they said “إِنكِحْنِي” (*inkaheeni*) and when they invited only for illicit relationship they said “سَافِحْنِي” (*saafiheeni*).

“سَافِحِي” (*as-safeeh*) means the fourth arrow among the arrows of chance or gambling which had no marking and was plain, for which no one had to pay and which was without any result {T}.

The Quran has first listed the women with whom wedlock is forbidden, and then declared that besides them the marriage is permitted with the rest. This will be “مُحْصِنَاتٍ غَيْرَ مُسَافِحِينَ” (*muhsineena ghaira musaafheeh*) as in 2:24.

“مُحْصِنَاتٍ” (*musaafeheen*) means as related under heading (H-Sd-N).

“مُسَافِحِينَ” (*musaafeheen*) means to waste the human energy in the sexual act. This is meant to point to a great truth. Let us first see what is the difference between “نِكَاحَ” (*nikah*) marriage and “زِنًا” (*zina*) fornication. Both include the sexual act and its associated pleasure, but in the former, personal pleasure is not the only aim, whereas in the latter, only personal pleasure is intended. In fornication both man and woman try to avoid pregnancy. This is what is meant by wasting the human effort. As such, man should avoid any fornication which avoids the responsibilities of being married, and if the purpose is only to obtain sexual pleasure, then according to the Quran it is not permitted.

In the same surah, it is stated later:

4:25	Chaste, not immoral and not those who take secret relations	مُحْصَنَاتٍ غَيْرِ مُسَفِّحَاتٍ وَلَا مُتَّحِدَاتٍ أَخْدَانٍ
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For “اِخْدَانٍ” (*akhdaan*), see under heading (Kh-Dh-N), which means secret friendship, although this word has appeared in the context of a slave girl of that time as well.

These three terms would mean as under:

- i. “مُحْصِنِينَ” (*muhseneen*): the form of married relation in which all the limits, rights and duties, and purpose are kept in mind.
- ii. “الشَّفَّاحُ” (*as-sifaah*): fornication which has no form of “*muhsinee*”, no matter even if it becomes “acceptable” in a society.
- iii. “اتَّخَذَ أَخْدَانًا” (*ittekhaazi akhdaan*): the fornication which is not permitted, even in permissive societies.

According to the Quran, only the form mentioned in (i) is permissible.

S-F-R

س ف ر

“السَّفَرُ” (*as-safr*) basically means to lift off a veil and make it evident.

Muheet says that “السَّفَرُ” (*as-safr*) means to display or highlight the evident part of something and “الْفَسْرُ” (*al-fasr*), from which “تَفْسِيرٌ” (*tafsir*) or explanation has been derived from, means to lay open the insides of something and to make it evident or clear. However, it means to unveil, distinct and make clear.

“سَفَرَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ” (*safaratil mar-ah*): the woman lifted the veil from her face {R}.

Ibn Faris says it means to open, to disperse and to be clear.

“السَّفَرُ” (*as-safr*) also means to sweep clean.

“الْمِسْفَرَةُ” (*al-misfarah*) means broom.

“سَفَرٌ” (*safar*) means to soil or make dirty.

“سَفَرَتِ الرِّيحُ الْغَيْمَ” (*as-safaratir reehul ghaim*) i.e. the wind dispersed the clouds.

“السَّافِرُ” (*as-saafir*) means a traveller.

“السُّفْرَةُ” (*as-sufrah*) food for the traveler which is prepared for the journey. After that it started meaning lunch box, and then “سُفْرَةٌ” (*sufrah*) began to mean cloth, mat or plastic that is laid out on the ground as a table e.g. in some eastern cultures {T}.

“سَفِيرٌ” (*safeer*) means one who arbitrates peace between nations, that is, an ambassador {T}, in a sense that he brings out what is in both the proponent’s hearts and clears up the matter.

“السَّافَرَةُ” (*as-safaaratu*), “السَّفَّارَةُ” (*as-siffaarah*): to try to make peace among nations {T}.

“السَّفَرُ” (*as-sifr*) a great book or a book which highlights the truth, the plural is “أَسْفَارٌ” (*asfarah*) as in 62:5.

“سَفَرُ الْكِتَابِ سَفَرًا” (*safaral kitaaba safra*): wrote the book {T}.

“سَافِرٌ” (*saafir*) means writer, plural of which is “السَّفَرَةُ” (*as-safarah*).

“أَسْفَرُ الصُّبْحِ” (*asfaras subh*): the day dawned (became bright).

The Quran says:

74:33	When the morning is well lighted (becomes bright)	وَالصُّبْحُ إِذَا أَسْفَرُ
80:38	some faces that day will be lighted (happy)	وُجُوهُ يَوْمٍ مُّسْفِرَةٌ
80:15	in the hands of the writers	بِأَيْدِي سَفَرَةٍ
2:184	during travel	عَلَى سَفَرٍ

“سَفَعُ” (*saf’un*) means to pull after holding something, to singe, to mark. It also means to slap.
 “سَفَحَ بِنَاصِيَتِهِ وَبِرِ جُلْمٍ” (*safaha bina siyatehi wabirijlihi*): caught him by the forelocks or the leg, and pulled him {T}.

The Quran says:

66:15	We will surely pull him by the forelocks (by catching hold of the forelocks), will pull them harshly	لَنَسْفَعًا بِالنَّاصِيَةِ
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It means that at last these powerful and rich opposing the Truth will be demeaned and demoralized and will be overpowered and defeated.

“السُّفْعَةُ” (*as-suf’ah*) means that heap of rubbish that lies in the ruins. Actually this word is used for blackish colour {T}.

Raghib says “سَفَعُ” (*saf’un*) means to catch a horse by its black forelocks and pull.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings. One is of blackish colour, and the second is to catch/hold something by hand.

“سَفَكَ” (*safak*): to let flow, usually it means to shed blood {T}.

“السَّفَاكُ” (*as-saffaak*): one who sheds too much blood, or a man who is fluent in some language {T}.

The Quran says:

2:30	will shed blood	يَسْفِكُ الدِّمَاءَ
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“السُّفْلُ” (*sifl*), “السُّفْلُ” (*as-sufli*): lowliness. It is the opposite of “عُلُوٌّ” (*ilwun*) and “عُلُوٌّ” (*ulwun*) which mean height, stature etc.

“الْأَسْفَلُ” (*al-asfal*): very low, it is the opposite of “أَعْلَى” (*aala*) which means very high.

“سِفْلَةُ النَّاسِ” (*siflatun naas*): lowly, mean people {T}.

The Arabs also call a man “السَّافِلَةُ” (*as-saafilah*), if he is a guest at a dinner and robs the host {M}.

The Quran says about the punishment of Loot’s nation:

11:82	turned the upper class into the lower class	جَعَلْنَا غَالِيَهَا سَافِلَهَا
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About the hypocrites, the Quran declares:

4:145	they live in the lowest level of hell	فِي الدَّرَكِ الْأَسْفَلِ مِنَ النَّارِ
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This means that they live in a state of continuous inner turmoil. This refers to their state in this life, while in the hereafter they will face the worst consequences as a result of what they did in this life.

5:95	the lowest, even worst	أَسْفَلَ سَافِلِينَ
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“سَفَنَ الشَّيْءَ” (*safanash shaiya*), “يَسْفِنُهُ سَفْنًا” (*yasfinuhu safna*): to pare something from the top or to rub it. “سَفِينَةٌ” (*safeenah*) has been derived from it and means a boat, perhaps because boats were made by scraping out big trunks of trees in the old days. This was how a place to sit inside a boat was made. Or because when it sails, the boat seems to be parting the water. “سَفَاءُنُ الْبَرِّ” (*safaa-inul bar*) means camels which are called boats of the desert {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

18:71	they both boarded the boat	رَكِبَا فِي السَّفِينَةِ
18:76	as far the matter related to the boat is concerned....	أَمَّا السَّفِينَةُ

“سَفَهَ” (*safah*) means stupidity, ignorance, nonsense, uneducated. “سَفِهَهُ” (*safihahu*): to persuade someone to ignorance, or stupidity, to kill someone. “سَفَهَ الشَّرَابُ سَفْهًا” (*safhash sharaaba safaha*): is said when a man drinks a lot but his thirst is not quenched. “تَوَبَّ سَفِيهًا” (*saubun safyeh*): a poorly and roughly woven cloth, but its basic meanings are being nervous and in a hurry as well, which are an indication of being emotive and not rationally thinking. “زِمَامٌ سَفِيهٌ” (*safyeeh*) is a person who is perturbed because of a camel which is not stable and its unpredictability causes concern to the rider - therefore can refer to immature intellect or poor logic {M}.

Those people whose hearts and minds are confused due to their inner psychological state which is in conflict and are called “سَفَاهَةً” (*sufaha-a*) by the Quran. Because of their such conduct they create imbalances in a society and behave like hypocrites (2:10-14). These people apparently consider themselves as very clever and smart but in reality they harm themselves while remaining unaware about the negative consequences of their wrong conduct (2:12).

At another place the word “سَفِيهٌ” (*safeehun*) has been used for imbeciles in 2:282. In 6:141, by adding “سَفَاهًا” (*safaha*) after “بِغَيْرِ عِلْمٍ” (*bighairi ilm*) i.e. without knowledge, it is declared that “سَفَاهَةً” (*safahah*) means not to use intellect and critical thinking. According to the Quran, not using human intellect and critical thinking is a very big mistake, as these people then cannot benefit from this ability to the maximum and as a consequence suffer in this life as well as in the next. *Momin* is the one who uses his intellect and critical thinking in the light of the Quranic values as revealed by Allah and takes full advantage of this life and then moves on to the next life with a developed Self. .

“سَفَاهَةً” (*safahah*) as used in 7:66 means foolishness, unawareness, ignorance.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:130	who can be unmindful of the nation of <i>Ibrahim</i> except one who has not deliberated upon his very self, who has never even thought about how a personality develops and why it is important?	وَمَنْ يَرْغَبْ وَ عَنْ مِلَّةِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ الْأَمْنِ سَفِيهَةً نَفْسَهُ
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Muheet says that it means to demean and to devalue oneself – not giving oneself the significance which it deserves and not appreciating the possession of a free will which is only available to human beings. The Quran highlights the significance of accepting the Quran as an external source of guidance with the permanent values. It also means that the belief in the existence of a Self and its ability to make choices is part of this conviction which requires guidance to develop itself. This possession of a free will which makes human beings superior to other creations in the world. Without accepting this fact the belief in God

becomes meaningless as it does not bring any change in the Self. Further details can be found under the heading (N-F-S).

S-Q-R

س ق ر

“السَّقَرُ” (*as-saqar*): heat of the sun.

“سَقَرَتْهُ الشَّمْسُ” (*saqaratus shams*): the sunlight melted it, burned him, and hurt him.

“السَّاقُورُ” (*as-saqoor*): a branding iron.

“السَّقَرُ” (*as-saqar*) also means to be distant and enmity {T, M, R}. The Quran has used this word to mean conditions existing in a state of hell

54:49	get a taste of the ‘ <i>saqar</i> ’ which distances you (deprive you) from the pleasures of life.	ذُوقُوا مَسَّ سَقَرَ
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S-Q-Te

س ق ط

“سَقَطَ الشَّيْءُ” (*saqatash shaiyu*): for something to fall down, that is, to fall off the roof, or to fall down while standing {T, M, R}.

“سَاقَطَهُ” (*saqaata*): to make one do a thing continuously {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

6:59	no leaf drops	وَمَا تَسْقُطُ مِنْ وَرَقَةٍ
19:25	that tree will drop fresh dates on you regularly	نُسَاقِطُ عَلَيْكَ رَطْبًا حَيًّا
26:187	drop on us	فَأَسْقِطْ عَلَيْنَا
52:44	that which drops	سَاقِطًا

Surah *Al-Airaf* says about the *Bani Israel*:

7:149	they repented	وَلَمَّا سَقِطَ فِي أَيْدِيهِمْ
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Taj says it means to be ashamed and surprised. *Zajaj* says it means to repent on what one has done (regret).

Ibn Faris says it means to wring one’s hand in repentance.

Muheet too says it means repentance. Similar meaning appears in the Quran for this word that is to repent at one’s foolishness and mistakes.

S-Q-F

س ق ف

“السَّقْفُ” (*as-saqf*): roof, plural is “سُقُفٌ” (*suquf*) (43:33).

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to be high and to be overshadowing.

“السَّقِيفَةُ” (*as-saqifah*): any place that has a roof over it. Usually it means a projected shed. The Arabs also term the sky as “سَقْفٌ” (*saqf*) because they think that it is the roof of the earth.

Surah *Al-Anbia* says:

21:32	we made the sky as a strong roof	وَجَعَلْنَا السَّمَاءَ سَقْفًا مَحْفُوظًا
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This means that the atmosphere is safe because whatever breakages take place in the heavenly bodies gets grounded or burned to dust in the atmosphere, and thus we are safe from its destruction, as if the sky is like a roof over the earth. In calling the sky as “سَقْفٌ” (*saqf*), the Arabic metaphor is also at work, since Arabs used “سَقْفٌ” (*saqf*) metaphorically to mean roof of the earth. The Quran too has used this word as a metaphor, it does not literally mean roof of a house.

“سَمَاءٌ” (*sama'a*) too does not mean the blue sky or ‘roof’ over our heads, but the atmosphere above us, or the heavenly bodies.

Details can be found in (S-M-W).

S-Q-M س ق م

“السَّقَامُ” (*as-saqam*), “السُّقْمُ” (*as-suqm*): illness, disease.
 “هُوَ سَقِيمٌ الصَّدْرُ عَلَيَّ” (*huwa saqeemus sadri alaihi*): he has prejudice against him.
 “قَلْبٌ سَقِيمٌ” (*qalbun saqeem*): unhappy and frustrated heart {T}.

The nation of *Ibrahim* was idol-worshippers and star gazers. *Ibrahim* used to tell people to give up this practice of having multiple gods besides Allah, and invited them to unity. In this context the Quran says:

37:88	He deliberated on the star being god, judged it correctly and then said: I am very frustrated by your false gods	فَتَنَظَّرَ نَظْرَةً فِي النُّجُومِ - فَقَالَ إِنِّي سَقِيمٌ
60:4	I am frustrated with you and those you follow other than Allah	إِنَّا بُرْءٌ وَ مِنْكُمْ وَمِمَّا تَعْبُدُونَ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ
6:77	I do not like such gods which change every second	لَا أُحِبُّ الْآفِلِينَ

S-Q-Y س ق ي

“السَّقْيُ” (*as-saqy*): to give someone a drink.
 “السَّقْيَا” (*as-suqya*): made him drink, gave him to drink.
 “السَّقَى” (*as-saqy*), “الْإِسْقَاءُ” (*al-isqaa*): These words have almost similar meanings. Some think that “سَقَى” (*saqy*) means to make one drink by mouth and “إِسْقَاءُ” (*isqaa*) means to give water or point out water.

Raghib says “سَقَى” (*saqy*) means to give something to drink or make him drink, and “إِسْقَاءُ” (*isqa*) means that you give someone a drink whether he drinks it or not. As such, “إِسْقَاءُ” (*isqaa*) is more composite than “سَقَى” (*saqy*).

“السَّقَايَةُ” (*as-siqayaa*): the place where water is given to drink or the pot or utensil used for giving a drink (12:70), or the arrangement for drinking (9:19).

“الْإِسْتِسْقَاءُ” (*al-istisqaa*): to ask for a drink of water, or ask for rain.

“السَّقِيُّ” (*as-saqiyyo*): the cloud which rains hard {M}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says “إِسْتَسْقَى” (*istasqaa*) in 2:60, which means to ask for a drink or to ask for rain.

Surah *Ash-Shura* says:

26:79	it is God who gives me to eat and drink	وَالَّذِي يُؤْتِيهِمْ مِنْ شَرِّهِمْ
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Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:66	We give you to drink what is in their body (honey in bees' stomach)	نُسْقِيكُمْ مِمَّا فِي بُطُونِ
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Surah *Ash-Shams* says about *Saleh's* camel:

91:13	look after God's camel and about its drink	نَاقِمَ اللَّيْلِ وَسُقْيَا
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In the story of *Yusuf* it is said "سِقَايَةً" (*siqayah*) in 12:70, this word has been used for a utensil which has also been called "صَوَاعُ" (*swa'a*) in 12:72.

“سَكَبَ الْمَاءُ وَ الدَّمْعُ” (*sakabal ma'a wad dama'a*): he shed tears and let the water flow.

“سَكَبَ الْمَاءُ” (*sakabal maa-oo*): water flowed.

“مَاءٌ سَاكِبٌ” (*maa un saakibun*), “مَسْكُوبٌ” (*maskub*): the water that flows on the earth's surface, which has not be dug out {T}. The scholars have also said it means to drop from above and flow. As such “مَاءٌ مَسْكُوبٌ” (*maauun masakub*) includes the meaning of a waterfall (which drops from a height). The Quran has used “مَاءٌ مَسْكُوبٌ” (*maa-inn maskub*) in 56:31, which means that in a society based on the permanent values, the to get the necessities of life no one will not be exploited. This means that one will not have to dig a well to get water. But in a society not based on these values, one will have to strive extremely hard to get these basic necessities of life (20:117).

“رَجُلٌ سَكْبٌ” (*rajulun sakb*): a happy man {M}.

“فَرَسٌ سَكْبٌ” (*farasun sakb*): a fast horse.

“السُّكُوتُ” (*as-sakt*): to be quiet, not to speak.

The difference between “سُكُوتٌ” (*sukut*) and “صَمْتُ” (*samt*) is that the former one is said for things which are able to speak, but remain silent, and the later one is for things which cannot speak at all. In other words, “صَمْتُ” (*samt*) can be said for anything whether it is able to speak or not.

“سَكَتَ الْغَضَبُ” (*sakat-al-ghazab*): his anger cooled down {T}.

The Quran says:

7:154	when <i>Moosa's</i> anger cooled down	وَلَمَّا سَكَتَ عَنْ مُوسَى الْغَضَبُ
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Raghib says “سُكُوتٌ” (*sukut*) has a kind of peace, so here the word “سَكَتَ” (*sakat*) has been used to mean silence or peace.

“سُكْرٌ” (*sukr*): to be intoxicated.

Raghib says this is a condition which comes between a man and his intellect. Usually this word is used for intoxication but such condition can also be produced by anger and in passionate love {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “surprise”.

“سَكَرٌ” (*sakar*): alcohol, intoxication (16:67).

“سَكْرَةٌ” (*sakrah*): stupor, unconsciousness. This is a condition of stupor.

The Quran has said “سَكْرَةُ الْمَوْتِ” (*sakaratul maut*) in 50:18, which means unconsciousness of death.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:43	do not go near <i>salaah</i> when you are intoxicated	لَا تَقْرَبُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَأَنْتُمْ سُكَارَى
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Here the word “سُكَارَى” (*sukara*) is usually taken to mean stupor, but *Lissan-ul-Arab* says that it means overwhelming of sleep.

“سُكَارَى” (*sukaara*) has been used for people who are out of their senses due to fear and tribulation (22:2, 75:72).

“سَكْرَةٌ” (*sakrah*) has been used for the stupor that is produced by an overflow of emotions.

“السَّكْرُ” (*as-sakr*): to close a canal.

“سَكَرَتِ الرِّيحُ” (*sakiratir reeh*): the wind became still.

“الْمَاءُ السَّاكِرُ” (*al-ma'us saakir*): standing water.

“سَكَرَ الْبَابُ” (*sakarul baab*): closed the door {T, R}.

“سَكَّرَهُ” (*sak-karahu*): strangled him.

Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

15:15	our eyes have been blinded (we have been hoodwinked)	سَكَّرَتْ أَبْصَارَنَا
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In surah *An-Nisa*:

4:43	when you are overwhelmed by sleep do not go near <i>salaat</i>	لَا تَقْرُبُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَ أَنْتُمْ سُكَارَى
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“سُكَارَى” (*sukarya*) is the plural form of “سَكْرَانٌ” (*sakran*) and “سَكْرَانَةٌ” (*sakranah*)

Later it is said:

4:43	until you know what you are saying	حَتَّى تَعْلَمُوا مَا تَقُولُونَ
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This means in a condition (sleepy condition) when you do not even know what you are saying. There is no use of saying your prayers in such a condition. It is evident from this verse that if a person does not understand what *salaah* is about; there is no use in attending *salaah*. The first thing is that you should understand what you are saying in *salaah*. Only then *salaah* is of any benefit.

The Quran is to be studied with a view to benefit from the values in our life. To believe that to recite the words without comprehension can be of some use, is a sort of superstition that was prevalent in the magic age. . The Quran was revealed to end these false practices and invites us repeatedly to understand the guidance through the use of intellect and reasoning.

S-K-N

س ك ن

“سُكُونٌ” (*sukun*): not to move, to stop {T}.

“سَكَنَ” (*sakana*), “سَكَنًا” (*sakanan*), “سُكْنَى” (*sukna*): to adopt the style, or to reside {M}.

Raghib says that “سُكُونٌ” (*sukun*) means for a mobile thing to become immobile. That is why this word means to make some place in one's country or abode.

“السُّكَّانُ” (*as-sukkaan*): a boat's oar.

“السَّكِينُ” (*as-sikkeen*): a knife (12:31), because according to *Raghib*, it turns the one who is slaughtered from mobility to immobility.

“مِسْكِينٌ” (*miskeen*): one whose movement has been reduced by hunger and deprivation. There is more of an element of being needy in it and refers to poverty.

“مِسْكِينٌ” (*miskeen*): he who is insulted and mean.

In surah *Al-Kahf*, the boat people have been called “مَسَاكِينٌ” (*masakeen*) in 18:79, because they were unable to do anything against the king's oppression {T}.

“الْمُسْكِنَةُ” (*al-maskinah*): hardship and strife which makes a man helpless {*Al-fazul Mutaradif*}.

“سُكُونٌ” (*sukun*): poverty and lowliness and weakness {*T*}.

“سَكَّنْتُهٖ تَسْكِينًا” (*sakantuhu taskinah*): I removed his tribulations and gave him peace of heart, or made him immobile.

The Quran says:

6:97	Allah made the night to give you peace	جَعَلَ اللَّيْلَ سَكَنًا
9:103	your prayer is cause of peace for them	إِنَّ صَلَاتَكَ سَكَنٌ لَهُمْ

Ibn Faris says that “السَّكَنُ” (*as-sakn*) means any favourite thing which provides peace and tranquillity.

“السَّكِينَةُ” (*as-sakinah*) means peace and contentment and honour.

Ar-rumani has said that this word means the same as “الْتَّيْبُ” (*at-ta'abbutu*), which means peace of mind {*Al-fazul Mutaradif*}.

“إِسْتَكَانَ” (*istakaan*) means to become demeaned and weak {*T*}. This is actually derived from (K-W-N) and not from (S-K-N).

The Quran has used this root to mean to reside somewhere or settle somewhere (2: 35).

“وَيْسٌ” (*wahnuun*), “ضَعْفٌ” (*zo'fun*) and “إِسْتِكَانَهُ” (*istakanahu*) have been used in 3:145 to mean the same thing, but the order in which they have appeared shows that “إِسْتِكَانَهُ” (*istakanahu*) is used for extreme weakness. Since “إِسْتِكَانَتٌ” (*istakanat*) is from (K-W-N), we have also mentioned it under this heading. “مَسْكَنَةٌ” (*maskanah*) has been described as God's wrath (2:61), because it is that inertia due to which a nation becomes ‘lifeless’ and is devoid of progressing forward.

Surah *At-Taubah* has used the words “فُقَرَاءٌ” (*fuqaraa*) and “مَسَاكِينٌ” (*masakeen*) together in 9:60. “مِسْكِينٌ” (*miskeen*) is one whose running business comes to a halt, or he is unable to take part in the struggle of life due to some mishap. In a Quranic system, no “مِسْكِينٌ” (*miskeen*) can be deprived of the necessities of life. He can acquire these things, not as a charity, but as his right.

Surah *Al-Balad* says:

90:15	he who feels lonely in a crowd, and he who is isolated by a society	يَتِيمًا ذَا مَقْرَبَةٍ
90:16	he who falls down due to some weakness, is trampled upon, the Quranic society gets established to provide support to the weak and lonely	أَوْ مَسْكِينًا دَامِئِرَةٍ

S-L-B

س ل ب

“السَّلْبُ” (*as-salb*): to wrench something from someone. Some say it means to snatch something from someone when he is not attentive.

Ibn Faris says it means to take something swiftly, or snatch it.

“السَّلُوبُ” (*as-saloob*): a female camel whose young one has been snatched from her {*M*}.

“شَجَرَةٌ سَالِيْبٌ” (*shajaratun saleeb*): a tree whose branches and leaves have fallen.

“السَّالِيْبُ” (*as-saleeb*): a woman whose child has died.

“السُّلْبَةُ” (*as-sulbah*): to be naked, to be without any clothes on the body {*T, R*}.

Surah *Al-Hajj* says:

22:73	if a fly snatches away something from them	وَأَنْ يَّسْلُبَهُمُ الذُّبَابُ شَيْئًا
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“السِّلَاحُ” (*as-silaah*), “السِّلَاحُ” (*as-silah*): a weapon of war, anything used in a battle to fight or to attack, arms, metal part of a weapon, sword or its sharpness, a bow without tension, stick. Plural is “أَسْلِحَةٌ” (*asleha*).

4.102	should take their weapons along	وَلْيَأْخُذُوا أَسْلِحَتَهُمْ
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“سَلَحَ” (*salah*), “يَسْلُحُ” (*yaslah*): for the birds to leave their droppings, but the Quran has not used this word in these meanings.

“سَلَخَ” (*salakha*), “يَسْلُخُ” (*yaslukhu*), “يَسْلُكُ” (*yaslakhu*): to skin an animal.

“سَلَخَتِ الْحَيَّةُ” (*salakhatil hayyah*): snake shed its skin.

“السِّلْكُ” (*as-silk*): snake skin.

“سَلَخَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ دِرْعَهَا” (*salakhatil mar'atu dir'aha*): the woman took off her shirt {T}.

It also means to separate a thing from another in such a way that no residual mark is left behind.

The Quran says:

36:37	we draw the day away from the night	اللَّيْلُ تَسْلُخُ مِنْهُ النَّهَارُ
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This word as used in this verse points to the fact that day is drawn away from night in such a way that there is not even a trace of daylight left in night.

“سَلَخَ الشَّهْرُ وَأَسْلَخَ” (*salakhash sharu wansalakh*): month passed {T} (9:5).

“إِنْسَلَخَ مِنْهُ” (*insalakha minhu*): leaving something, or donning it off. He has become naked or is devoid of it.

Surah *Al-Airaf* posts an example:

7:175	We gave him our laws and he put them on one side like a snake sheds its skin	أَتَيْنَاهُ آيَاتِنَا فَانْسَلَخَ مِنْهَا
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This can be related to the state of the Muslims who claim to have the Quran as a book of guidance, but have abandoned it as quoted in the verse earlier. But thanks to Allah, the Quran is preserved in its original text and anyone looking for guidance can study it and can benefit from its permanent values.

“السَّلْسَلَةُ” (*as-salsalah*): to link a thing with another.

“السَّلْسِلَةُ” (*as-silsilah*): a chain.

“تَسْلَسَلُ الْمَاءُ” (*tasalsalal ma'a*): the water went continuously down the throat {T, R}.

“سَلَّ” (*sal*): to pull something. See heading (S-L-L).

The Quran has used “السَّلْسِلَةُ” (*silsilah*) in 69:32 to mean chain, plural of which is “سَلْسِلٌ” (*salasil*) as in 76:4. One link gets linked to another and so on, and thus forms a chain.

“السُّلْطُ” (*as-sult*), “السَّيْلُطُ” (*as-saleet*): hard and strong.
 “الْأَسْلُطُ” (*at-tasleet*): to make dominating, to give domination and power.
 “سَلَّطَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ” (*sallatulaahu alaihi*): Allah gave dominance and power over him (4:90).

Ibn Faris says it means domination and power.

“سُلْطَانُ النَّارِ” (*saltuwanun naar*): for the fire to flare up {T}.

“السُّلْطَانُ” (*as-sultaan*): reason, proof, sign, evidence. {T}.

Mohammed bin yazeed has said that it has been derived from “سَلَيْطُ” (*saleet*) which means olive oil which is used to provide light. As such, “سُلْطَانُ” (*sultan*) will only be that argument which is based on reasoning and evidence with capacity to enlighten itself and show any matter like light {T}.

The Quran says:

37:156	or do you have clear proof	أَمْ لَكُمْ سُلْطَانٌ مُبِينٌ
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But as per the meaning of “السُّلْطُ” (*as-sult*), it also means domination and power. This word has been used several times by the Quran to mean this.

In surah *Ibrahim* it is said that God sent the messengers with “بَيِّنَاتٍ” (*bayyenaat*) clear reasoning (14:9), but the opponents refused to accept them saying that they would not obey until they are under their governance.

Iblees is told in surah *Al-Hijr*:

15:42	you will have no power over those who decide to follow My guidance	إِنَّ عِبَادِي لَيْسَ لَكَ عَلَيْهِمْ سُلْطَانٌ
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This word has also been used to mean capable or having the right to something in surah *Bani Israel* (17:33). Here domination is implied in the meaning.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:153	And We gave <i>Moosa</i> domination and power	وَأَتَيْنَا مُوسَى سُلْطَانًا مُبِينًا
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Surah *Al-Haqq* also has used “سُلْطَانِيَّةً” (*sultaniah*) in this meaning (69:29).

In surah *Ar-Rahman* there is a verse which points to a great fact:

	If you have the power (the capability) to go beyond the planets or the stars, then do it, go beyond them	يُعْشِرُ الْحَرِّ وَالْإِنْسِ إِنْ اسْتَطَعْتُمْ أَنْ تَنْفُذُوا مِنْ أَقْطَارِ السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ فَانْفُذُوا
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Here all mankind is addressed which includes both uncivilized and civilized people. Death is a mystery for human beings. The universe around us is also a mystery and modern man has tried hard to go beyond the earth's orbit to satisfy his inquisitiveness e.g. moon landing and sending probes to the mars. In this verse there is a pointer to an important sign saying you wish to go beyond the limits of this material visible universe. However, there is a limit of human physical self which cannot go beyond the physical world. The Quran has pointed to an ability which man can attain through the following of the permanent values which is called “سُلْطَانُ” (*sultan*), i.e. the power to be attained through obeying Allah's laws. The Quran has declared through the Messenger's (*pbuh*) reference:

17:80	And bestow me with the helping power	وَأَجْعَلْ لِي مِنْ لَدُنْكَ سُلْطَانًا نَصِيرًا
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We know the fact that human physical self ultimately dies and has limitations. However, the Quran deals with the human Self which operates through choices and decision making in this life and has the ability to

survive our death. The Quran points to this fact that if man chooses to live within the guidance then he can this power or “سُلْطَانٌ” (*sultan*). This helps self-development and strengthens it and gradually makes it develop ability to go beyond the physical boundaries of this visible universe. This is only possible by accepting the Quranic guidance. But this does not mean the so-called spiritual development propagated by monasticism. This “سُلْطَانٌ” (*sultan*) means such power and domination as annihilates all evil forces and establishes Allah’s law effectively in a society. Physical forces can take man to the moon and stars, but they will keep him within this universe. Only human personality can go beyond, provided that it creates the “سُلْطَانٌ” (*sultan*) to which the Quran has pointed.

S-L-F

س ل ف

“سَلَفَ الْأَرْضَ” (*salaf al arda*), “أَسْلَفَهَا” (*aslafaha*): to cultivate the land or to level it.
 “سَلَفَ الشَّيْءُ” (*salafush shaiyi*): the thing passed, went ahead.
 “سَلَفَ فُلَانٌ” (*salafa fulan*): that man went ahead.
 “أَسْلَفَ” (*aslafa*): sent ahead, presented.
 “السَّالِفُ” (*as-saalif*): the one who passes ahead
 “السَّالِفَةُ” (*as-salifah*): predecessor who stays ahead in battle or travel {R}.

Ibn Faris says it means to be ahead and to supersede, to excel.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:275	that which has been taken earlier, belongs to him	فَلَهُ مَا سَلَفَ
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Surah *Az-Zakhruf* says about annihilated civilisations :

43:56	we made them predecessors	وَجَعَلْنَاهُمْ سَلَفًا
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Above verse is referring to nations from the past whose history now remain as an example.

Surah *Al-Haqq* says:

69:24	whatever you did earlier	بِمَا أَسَلَفْتُمْ
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S-L-Q

س ل ق

“السَّلْقُ” (*as-salq*): this root basically means to rise or climb {M}.
 “تَسَلَّقَ الْجِدَارَ” (*tasallaqil jidaar*): he climbed the wall.
 “تَسَلَّقَ عَلَى فِرَاشِهِ” (*tasallaqa ala firashehi*): due to sadness and grief he couldn’t sleep and kept changing sides in the bed .
 “سَلَقَ فُلَانًا بِالسَّوْطِ” (*salaqa fulanan bis saut*): he skinned the man with his whip.
 “السَّلَيقَةُ” (*as-saleeqah*): the footsteps and hoof marks on a treaded path , thin, fine bread, also temperament {T}.

Raghib writes that “السَّلْقُ” (*as-salq*) means to lay down something forcibly, either with the hands or by word of mouth {R}, and “سَلَقَ فُلَانًا” (*salaqa fulana*) means he flattened him {T}.

The Quran says:

33:19	These people hurt you with their words (remarks)	سَلَفُوْكُمْ بِالْأَسِنَّةِ
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Say accusations against you (the messenger), wish to control and overpower you with these satirical utterings .

Ibn Faris says it has so many different meanings that it is difficult to find a common thread though all.

However from its use in the Quran, the term predominantly has an element of causing hurt to someone else.

S-L-K

س ل ك

“سَلَكَ” (*salak*) actually means for one thing to enter another or make it to enter.
 “سَلَكَ يَدَهُ فِي الْحَبِيبِ” (*salaka yadahu fil jabeeb*): he put his hand into his shirt front {T}.

While explaining their difference, *Muheet* says that “خَيْطٌ” (*khait*) is any string that is either used for sewing or as a garland around the neck, but the string in which pearls etc. are put, is called “سِلْكٌ” (*silk*).
 The string which is already adorned with pearls etc. is called “سِمِطٌ” (*simt*) {M}.
 “السُّلُوكُ” (*as-salook*) means to enter a path {M}.
 “سَلَكَ” (*salak*) is to walk or make to walk, to enter or make to enter.
 “أَسْلَكَ” (*aslak*): to make someone walk, to make someone or something to enter {T}.

The Quran says:

15:12	this way We enter it into the hearts of criminals	كَذَٰلِكَ نَسْلُكُهُ فِي قُلُوبِ الْمُخْرِمِينَ
20:53	And made pathways for you (on the earth)	وَسَلَكْ لَكُمْ فِيهَا سُبُلًا
71:20	so that you walk on them (travel on them)	لَتَسْلُكُوا مِنْهَا

S-L-L

س ل ل

“أَسْلَلْتُ” (*as-salal*): to extricate something quietly and with softness.

Ibn Faris has also added, extricating something secretly, in its basic meaning.

“سَيْفٌ” (*saifun saleel*): the sword that has been pulled out of the scabbard.
 “السَّلَالَةُ” (*as-sulalah*): the part that which is extricated {T}.
 “الْمَسْلُولُ” (*al-maslool*): that which is extracted, the man or animal whose testicles have been removed (made impotent) {M}.

The Quran says that man was created from “سُلَالَةٍ مِنْ طِينٍ” (*sulaalatim min teen*) according to 23:14. Here it means a substance which has been culled from the matter both organic and inorganic. We know our body is composed of organic and inorganic matter such as found in the soil. .

“أَسْلَلْتُ” (*insalla*) and “تَسَلَّلْتُ” (*tasallal*): he went away secretly, slipped away quietly.
 “السَّلَاةُ” (*as-sallah*): to steal secretly, theft.
 “السَّالُّ” (*as-saal*), “السَّلَالُ” (*as-sallaal*), “الْأَسَلُّ” (*al-asallu*): thief {T}.

Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:63	those of you who slip away quietly	الَّذِينَ يَتَسَلَّلُونَ مِنْكُمْ
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Since this is the root from which the word “إِسْلَامٌ” (*Islam*) is derived, its basic meanings must be comprehended properly, because these meanings will be used to explain various aspects of the word *Islam*.

“سَلِمَ” (*sa-lima*): he became clean (or free) from all sorts of faults, limitations, weaknesses. All his shortcomings were removed.

“سَلَّمَ الدَّلْوُ” (*salamad dalau*): he prepared a strong bucket (e.g. for drawing water from a well).

In surah Al-Baqrah it is said about the cow of *Bani Israel*:

2:71	It is free from all bodily marks (faults) and is spotless	مُسْلِمَةً لَا شَيْءَ فِيهَا
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As such “سَلِمَ” (*sa-lima*): basically means to be pure and to be without any blemish. This is in relation to the complete development of human abilities so that no failings and inadequacies remain in the Self.

The other meaning of this root is to be protected from dangers, accidents, or disasters.

Ibn Faris has said that it means more of health and wellbeing than anything else.

“سَلِمَ مِنَ الْأَفَةِ سَلَامَةً” (*salima minal aafateh salamah*): he remained safe from disasters.

“سَلَّمَهُ اللَّهُ تَسْلِيمًا” (*sallamahullahu tasleemah*): Allah kept him safe from any disaster.

The Quran has mentioned one attribute of God as “الْأَسْلَامُ” (*as-salam*) in 59:23, which is generally taken to mean “free of all blemishes and weaknesses”. However, Taj-ul-Uroos says that those who have used this meaning have committed a grave error. This is because “الْأَسْلَامُ” (*as-salam*) is something from which protection is sought, and “سَالِمٌ” (*salim*) is one who seeks protection, or someone who wants to be protected against evil or misfortune that is imminent. Thus Allah has been pronounced “الْأَسْلَامُ” (*as-salam*) because He has protected all creations from disasters and His system e.g. the Solar System is thus running well protected without interference from outside for a time appointed. Therefore, “سَالَامٌ” (*salaam*) would also mean to be safe from disasters and troubles. This is the second meaning of the root.

“الْأُسْلَمُ” (*as-sullam*) means a ladder, i.e, a safe and dependable means for climbing. Thus the third meaning of this root is the means through which somebody can reach new heights safely and reliably.

“الْأَسْلَمُ” (*as-silm*) means to live peacefully and amicably. It means amity and thus the fourth meaning of this root would be to live peacefully and to establish peace and security for all in the world.

“تَسَالَمَتِ الْخَيْلُ” (*tasaalamatil khail*): horses moving together, synchronizing their feet and galloping in tandem, and for none of the horses doing something which may frighten other horses or cause stampede. This projects a concept of harmony and team work of an Islamic Society.

“الْأَسْلَمُ” (*as-silmu*), “الْأَسْلَامُ” (*as-salsaam*): obedience, to bow before. Therefore, the fifth basic meaning of the root would be to completely and willingly follow the laws of the Quran.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that S-L-M basically has the element of compassion and humility {*Al-ilm-ul-akhlaaq*}.

“إِسْتَسْلَمَ تَكَمَ الطَّرِيقُ” (*istaslam akamat tareeq*): he walked in the middle of the road and kept straight path.

“قَالُوا سَلَامًا” (*qaalu sal-ah*): they adopt the balanced path as defined in the Quran and do not do anything that is against the permanent values. Thus the sixth meaning of this root would be to adopt the balanced path of moderation and to avoid things which have negative influences and are obstructive.

“إِسْتَلَمَ الزَّرْعُ” (*istalamz zar-u*): the ears of corn came out. This is the seventh meaning of this root which refer to the multiplied reward of human righteous efforts.

“السَّالِمَةُ” (*as-salimah*): refers to a woman who is extremely pretty and attractive. Thus the eighth meaning of this root refer to beauty and pleasant looks.

To summarise all this Islam “الإِسْلَامُ” (*al-islam*) is the name of a system in which all shortcomings of an individual are addressed and his potentials are fully developed. The system in which he/she is given protection from the negative forces and influences and he/she feels secure. The individual lives in peace and works to extend this peace to his fellow human beings across the world. He lives in complete harmony with others in his society and does nothing to cause annoyance to others and thus contribute to imbalance in the society. . This is only possible when he willingly follows the permanent values of the Quran He does not cross the defined limits knowingly and believes in the working of the law of requital. This way his efforts will be fruitful and do not go waste. Not only will his own personality be balanced and develop further, but he will contribute effectively for the well being of others.

This is the path that will result in success. If anyone adopts any other path, he will not be able to produce these results and he will ultimately be a loser (3:84). This is called Islam and is preserved within the folds of the Quran (20: 47). This means that Islam = The Quran.

The Quran has used the word “مُسْلِمٌ” (*muslim*) extensively that it is not possible to mention all references. Some selected ones are presented:

2:71	he is free from all faults and is impeccable	مُسْلِمَةً لَا شَيْءَ فِيهَا
2:33	when you have given (handed over)	إِذَا سَلَّمْتُمْ
8:43	(you had started to quarrel among yourselves) so Allah protected you from its destructive effects	وَلَكِنَّ اللَّهَ سَلَّمَ
52:38	reaching loftiness	سَلَّمَ
8:61	amity	وَأَنْ جَنَحُوا لِلسَّلَامِ
2:112	obedient	مَنْ أَسْلَمَ

Surah *Ar-Rom* has mentioned “إِسْلَامٌ” (*islam*) and “إِيمَانٌ” (*iman*) separately (30:53). “إِيمَانٌ” (*iman*) means to believe in something which is Ture and “إِسْلَامٌ” (*islam*) is to then follow it with complete unity of thought and conviction. As against those who have accepted the faith by word of mouth, but their hearts are devoid of the faith. They too are said to be “مُسْلِمٌ” (*muslim*), but not “مُؤْمِنٌ” (*momin*) (49:14).

Surah *An-Namal* has used the word “مُسْلِمِينَ” (*muslemin*) to mean those who do not break the limits, or transgress them, but rather become obedient (27:3).

Surah *Maryam* has used the word “سَلَامٌ” (*salam*) opposite to “لَعْوٌ” (*laghu*) which means useless things – something which wastes time and energy.

A man with these characteristics has been called one with a “سَلِيمٌ” (*saleem*) heart (26:89), and a nation with these characteristics is called “أُمَّةٌ مُسْلِمَةٌ لَكَ” (*ummatan muslimal-laka*), or a nation which follows the laws of Allah (2:128). Every individual of this nation has a duty to say “سَلَامٌ عَلَيْكُمْ” (*salamun alaikum*) to everyone he meets (7:46). It means that I wish you peace and security and all the good things mentioned above. The other returns the same complements and thus the whole society rings with the sounds of “سَلَامًا” (*salaman salaman*).

It is said in 3:66 about *Ibrahim* that he was neither a Jew nor a Christian, but rather “حَنِيفًا مُسْلِمًا” (*hanifan muslima*). This is the title used for followers of Allah’s Deen, even before the advent of the Quran (22:78). To belong to some sect is against *Islam*, because sectarianism is against the Quranic teachings (30:32) - the Quran has declared mankind as one community (2:213).

“مُسْلِمٌ” (*muslim*) and “مُشْرِكٌ” (*mushrik*) are opposite of each other at thought and belief level, same is meant by “كُفْرٌ” (*kufur*) and “إِسْلَامٌ” (*islam*) (9:74). It must be well understood that a *Muslim* can never be a criminal, if he commits a crime, then he is technically not a *Muslim* anymore. That is why the Quran says:

68:35	Would We make Muslims as criminals?	أَفَتَجْعَلُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ كَالْمُجْرِمِينَ
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Therefore he who follows Allah's laws is a *Muslim*.

“الإسلام” (*al-islam*) is the code of conduct for life that Allah has designated for mankind available as an alternative and it is upto us to accept it or not to accept it. No other code of life is acceptable to Allah than *Islam* – because this is not based on human emotions and is based on the permanent values which do not change with time.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:82	Do these people prefer a <i>Deen</i> other than that designated by Allah?	أَفَعَيِّرْ دِينَ اللَّهِ يَتَّبِعُونَ
3:82	(Even though) everything in the heavens and the earth is subjected to His laws accepting it willingly or unwillingly and at every step they have to follow his law	وَلَهُ اسْلَمَ مَنْ فِي السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ طُوعاً وَكَرْهاً وَإِلَيْهِ يُرْجَعُونَ

After that it is said:

3:84	And if man wants to experiment (another Deen) then he can try, but then he will find that ultimately he is the loser	وَمَنْ يَتَّبِعْ غَيْرَ الْإِسْلَامِ دِينًا فَلَنْ يُقْبَلَ مِنْهُ
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Anyone who adopts any other code of life except *Islam* will not be accepted i.e. will not get the benefit as one will get by following Islam. This is the same code of life that was given to all previous messengers and ultimately was completed with the advent of the Quran.

Allah has chosen this code of life for all humanity (5:3). As such, under the Sun, there is no other code of life other than that which Allah has termed “الإسلام” (*al-islam*), and is not to be found anywhere else except in the Quran. The followers of this *Deen* are called “مسلمين” (*muslimeen*), and a “مسلم” (*muslim*) is one who believes that the Quran is a complete code of life revealed by Allah . Since it is complete therefore there is no need for any other messenger.

S-L-W س ل و

“سَلْوَى” (*salwa*): anything which provides consolation, reassurance.

“السَّلْوَى” (*as-salwa*): honey, as well as meat {T}.

“سَلْوَةٌ مِنَ الْغَيْشِ” (*salwatun minal aish*): a comfortable life which is free from fear and tribulation {M}.

“سَلَاهُ عَنْهُ تَسْلِيَةً” (*salahu unhu tasleehi*): he made him forget his grief {T}.

“السَّالِي” (*as-saali*): one who forgets sadness and grief {M}.

“سَلَاهُ” (*salaahu*): he gave up his memory and mitigated his sorrow {T}.

“السَّلْوَى” (*as-salwa*): a white coloured bird which the *Bani Israel* were given to eat in the valleys of *Sinai* (2:57) {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means a comfortable life with plenty of luxuries.

Raghib says that it means anything which gives solace.

Also see under heading (M-N-N)

Among the messengers of the *Bani Israel*, *Suleman* had a prominent position due to his fame and execution of power. He was the son of *Dawood* (38:30) and his heir (27:16). He was had great desire to acquire knowledge and had developed the ability make effective decisions (27:15). Although in those days the kingdom was acquired just for being the king's son, *Suleman* was designated king because of his special qualities. Civilized and uncivilized people (*djinn* and *inns*) were included in his armies and cavalry brigades (27:17). His naval fleet was also very famous at the time. The Quran has quoted saying that the winds were made subservient to him (21:28), meaning that he used his knowledge of the winds to employ his ships.. The rebellious mountainous tribes were brought under control by employing them on different tasks during his reign (21:82). They used to construct big buildings, design statues and draw pictures for him (34:12-13). During this period, the nation of *Saba* was ruling over the eastern part of Yemen, and they were Star worshipers. They were ruled by a queen. Suleman went to war with her nation which eventually became subservient to Allah (27:20-44). The Quran has noted some of this detail by stating that his army had passed through the valley of "نمل" (*namal*) (27:18-19). "هُدْ هُدْ" (*huud huud*) was an officer in this army (27:20-21).

Suleman was a grand and powerful king but his heir proved to be very weak (34:14). The Torah mentions him as Solomon in detail. As happens in human reporting of the history the Jews have fabricated a lot of stories of sorcery and superstition about him. The Torah carries some of these stories and narrations which are refuted by the Quran (2:102).

S-M-D

س م د

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is to keep going without stopping.

"سَمَدًا" (*samada*), "سُمُودًا" (*samooda*): to raise the head high out of pride {T}.
 "سَمَدَتِ الْإِبِلُ فِي سَيْرِهَا" (*samadatil ibilu fee saireha*): the camels went straight ahead with speed. From this the meaning is derived that they did so out of rebellion and pride, or that they did as they liked.
 "سَمَدًا" (*samada*), "يَسْمَدُ" (*yasmadu*) means to be pushed high.
 "سَامِدٌ" (*saamid*): one who is left standing in wonderment, perhaps because he too stands with his head high.

Ibn-ul Airabi says it means a man who is engaged in the pleasures of life and neglects his responsibility {T}.

Muheet says that "السُّمُودُ" (*as-sumud*) means for the face to be distorted due to worries and grief {M}.

The Quran says about the opponents:

53:60-63	You ridicule instead of worrying because you are unaware of the (bad) results that your deeds are going to produce	وَتَضْحَكُونَ وَلَا تَبْكُونَ وَأَنْتُمْ سَامِدُونَ - فَاسْجُدُوا لِلَّهِ وَاعْبُدُوا
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According to this sentence "سَامِدُونَ" (*samidoon*) would mean to be unaware. But after that it is said "فَاسْجُدُوا لِلَّهِ وَاعْبُدُوا" (*fasjudul lahi wa 'bedu*). Here "سَامِدُونَ" (*saamedoon*) would mean that you are very rebellious and proud, and do whatever suits you. It is better for you to leave this path and willingly follow Allah's guidance.

”السَّمْرَةُ“ (*as-sumrah*): fair complexion (as colour of wheat).

”السَّمْرَاءُ“ (*as-samra'a*): wheat.

”السَّمَرُ“ (*as-samara*): night or conversation at night, nightly tales.

”السَّامِرُ“ (*as-saamir*): a congregation for story telling at night. It is also used for a story teller, singular as well as plural (23:67).

”السَّمِيرُ“ (*as-sameer*) means story teller.

”المُسَامِرُ“ (*al-musaamir*): a companion or fellow participant in a gathering at night for gossip and story telling.

”سِمَارَةُ اللَّيْلِ“ (*simaratul lail*): to talk at night.

”سَمِيرٌ“ (*samiyar*) also means period, era {R}.

”السَّامِرَةُ“ (*as-saamirah*), ”السَّمْرَةُ“ (*as-samarah*): a Jewish tribe. They differ in some things with the mainline Jews, for instance, they believe that no messenger will come after *Moosa*. They also believe in the caste system. They think that the city of *Nablus* (where they lived) is the holy city. There are two sects among them, *kushaan* and *dushaan*. These are the people whom the *samari* is said to have led to worship the golden calf built by him after *Moosa*, had gone up the mount to receive the commandments from God.

Muheet says ”السَّامِرَةُ“ (*as-saamirah*) is also a place in Palestine and a tribe as well which resides in *Nablus*. They are very few in number and believe that they become impure if touched by others {M} (20:97).

But modern day research shows that this chap was an individual of the *sameri* tribe, not *Bani Israel*. Three thousand years before Christ, there were two nations living in Iraq. One nation which had come from the south was Arab, and the other which probably came from the north was called Sameri. Although Sameri tribe had Iraq as its motherland, it had spread out afar out. History has proven their relations with the Egyptians. It seems that this person who has been called *Sameri* by the Quran in 20:85 had become a disciple of *Moosa* and had left the place along with *Bani Israel*. But it seems that *Moosa's* teachings had not affected him and he never accepted these from heart (20:96).

But if ”السَّامِرِيُّ“ (*as-saamiri*) has been derived from the root ”سَمَرٌ“ (*samara*), then it means story teller. The way the story tellers mislead the nation (simple folk) is known to everyone. Our own history is testimony to that fact that when we left the facts and truths of the Quran and diverted ourselves to myths and stories, we fell into ignominy. Gradually our Deen has turned into merely some mythical stories and the Quranic truths are ignored by the majority.

”السَّمْعُ“ (*as-sama*): hearing part of the ear. It also means listening, and sometimes even ear.

”سَمْعٌ“ (*sama*): that which is listened to. It also means to listen and also one who makes one to listen, although some scholars have refuted the later meaning.

”اسْتَمَعَ إِلَيْهِ“ (*istama-a ilaih*) means to be attentive to someone, to lend an ear and to listen attentively.

The Quran has said ”يَسْتَمِعُونَ إِلَيْكَ“ (*yastami-oona ilaik*) for those who appear to be very attentive but actually are not listening (10:32). The Quran calls them deaf because they do not employ their intellect and thus do not benefit from listening (10:42).

4:46

listen to us, even if you are not heard

اسْمَعْ غَيْرَ مُسْمَعٍ

Raghib says it is said satirically for someone to have turned deaf, and otherwise it is said as a prayer. Sometimes ”سَمْعٌ“ (*sama*) means understanding and method, i.e. ”أَسْمَعُ“ (*asma*) means to make someone

understand too. This word is also used for obedience, i.e. “اسْمَعُونَ” (*isma-oon*) means “أَطِيعُونَ” (*atee-oon*) in 2:93.

“سَمِعَ لَهُ” (*sami-a lahu*): accepted it, agreed to it.

The Quran has mentioned eyesight and hearing and “قلب” (*qalb*) for acquiring knowledge. Eyesight and hearing are the senses through which a man knows about things. These are means for perceptual knowledge. The mind conceives an image after receiving data from these senses. Thus through eyesight, hearing and seeing it through intellect, one acquires knowledge.

The Quran lays a lot of stress on perceptual knowledge which helps us to develop concepts. These concepts are then used for furthering our knowledge through the use of critical thinking skills. It says that those who do not employ their hearing, eyesight and reasoning are dwellers of a society which is bound to be left behind and is equivalent of hell on earth (7:179).

Also see (Q-L-B) and (B-Sd-R). It also says that when a man's emotions overwhelm him, his means of acquiring knowledge do not let him reach the right conclusion (47:16-17). We notice how someone can become blinded in rage. One can sometime be overwhelmed by emotions..

In greed a man can do things which are otherwise laughable or silly. If biased, one can never accommodate the other's point of view. Just like when intoxicated, one's senses do not work properly, similarly these do not work properly when one is overwhelmed by emotions as well.

This is termed by the Quran as:

2:7	To be blinded, to be deaf, and hearts to be sealed	خَتَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَىٰ قُلُوبِهِمْ وَعَلَىٰ سَمْعِهِمْ وَعَلَىٰ أَبْصَارِهِمْ غِشَاوَةٌ
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See heading (Kh-T-M). Knowledge can only produce good results under the guidance of the revelation, because it gives us those values of life which are free from human emotions. Human emotions bias our decision making and thus misguide us in the long run. Human intellect when alone will make any laws, these will never be free from the emotional bias and thus will have flaws.

(*istama*) to eavesdrop (72:1), to listen very attentively (42:38), not tinged with emotion. “سَمَّاعٌ” (*samma*) also means spy {T} (9:47)

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:20	how well he listens and how well he sees	أَبْصَرُوهُ وَاسْمِعْ
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Ibn Faris says “مُسْمِعٌ” (*mus-m'i*) and “مُسْتَمِعٌ” (*mustami'i*) also means praise of beauty and fame.

S-M-K

س م ك

“السَّمَكَ” (*as-samk*): height of a house or ceiling.

“قَدَّسَمَكُهُ” (*qad samakahu*): he made him lofty, raised him {R}.

“السَّمَكَ” (*as-simaak*): something used to make something lofty, or to raise something.

“الْمِسْمَاكُ” (*al-mismaak*): wooden pole with which a tent is raised.

“السَّمَكَ” (*as-samak*) means fish, because it is high or raised (in the middle):

The Quran says:

79:28	God raised the height of sky (or its roof)	رَفَعَ سَمَكَهَا
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It means that He raised the atmosphere to great heights. (The height of space is unlimited).

“السَّمُّ” (*as-sum*): narrow hole like a needle’s eye (7:40), or the openings of the ear and nose. May mean poison

“مَسَامٌ” (*masaam*): pores on skin.

“السَّمَامُ” (*as-samaam*): any light and fast moving thing.

“السَّمُومُ” (*as-samoom*): fast, hot wind which generally blows in the summer months (in the hot regions) {T}.

The Quran says

56:42	In scorching fire and scalding water	فِي سَمُومٍ وَخَمِيمٍ
15:27	Scorching fire	نَارِ السَّمُومِ

Ibn Faris described the basic meaning of this root as the spot from where you enter something. He writes that poison is called “سَمٌ” (*samma*) because it enters into the body.

“سَمُومٌ” (*samom*) means hot air because it enters into the body due to its high velocity.

Raghib writes that “سَمَةٌ” (*sammah*) means that it entered something, while “سَمُومٌ” (*samom*) as that hot air that appears to affect like poison.

“سَمِنَ” (*samin*), “سَمَانَةٌ” (*samanah*): he became plump, became fat.

“سَامِنٌ” (*saamin*), “سَمِينٌ” (*sameen*): the plural is “سِمَانٌ” (*simaan*) and means plump {T}.

The Quran says:

12:43	fat cows	بَقَرَاتٍ سِمَانٍ
51:27	fat calf	بِعِجْلٍ سَمِينٍ

“أَسَمَنَ الرَّجُلُ” (*asmanar rajul*): man became fat.

“أَسَمَنَهُ” (*asmanahu*): fattened him, put on weight {T}.

Surah *Al-Haashiya* says about the sustenance in a hellish society:

88:7	It does not fatten (does not develop the body)	لَا يُسَمِّنُ
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How can sustenance of ignominy can help to grow?

“السَّمْنُ” (*as-samn*) means saturated butter, which is fattening.

“سَمَاءٌ” (*sama-a*), with plural form “سَمَوَاتٌ” (*samawaat*) means sky because it is high and overshadows the earth. It actually means anything that is over you and overshadows you.

“سَمَاءٌ” (*sama-a*): every roof over your head. *Fuqah-ul-lugha* has also said that this word has this meaning:

Raghib says that everything is “سَمَاءٌ” (*sama-a*) in relation to a thing below it, and everything in relation to the thing above is called “أَرْضٌ” (*arz*).

Clouds and rain as well are called “سَمَاءٌ” (*sama-a*). Greenery and plants are called “سَمَاءٌ” (*sama-a*) as well because they are higher than the earth {T}, {*Ibn Qateebah*}.

“إِسْمٌ” (*ism*) means a sign with which one recognizes something.

Names are also called “إِسْمٌ” (*ism*). Plural is “أَسْمَاءٌ” (*asma-a*).

“سَمِيٌّ” (*sammi*) means of a similar name and equal.

“مُسَامَاةٌ” (*musaamah*) means mutual respect {T}.

“سَمَّى تَسْمِيَةً” (*samma tasmeeh*): to keep a name, to name something.

“الْمُسَمَّى” (*al-musamma*): name that is kept or given, said to be, nominated, designated, fixed and known {T}.

Mufaradaat says:

	until the “musamma” is known, names are of no use	مَعْرِفَةُ الْأَسْمَاءِ لَا تَحْصُلُ إِلَّا بِمَعْرِفَةِ الْمُسَمَّى
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It means that *Adam* (human beings) has been given the ability to recognize things by their constituents and can characterise these by their properties and can identify them accordingly by giving them different names.

The Quran has used “أَرْضٌ وَسَمَاءٌ” (*arz o sama-a*) at many places. There is no doubt that this earth of ours is also called “أَرْضٌ” (*arz*) i.e. Earth, but everything in relation to (Sama) heavens seen as above is called “أَرْضٌ” (*arz*) as well. Therefore “أَرْضٌ وَسَمَاءٌ” (*arz o sama-a*) would mean the lows and highs of the universe as visible to us. When “أَرْضٌ” (*arz*) is to be used against “سَمَاءٌ” (*sama-a*) then “سَمَاءٌ” (*sama-a*) would also include the entire universe, and “أَرْضٌ” (*arz*) would refer to the society and civilization of humans. Therefore, “سَمَاءٌ” (*sama-a*) or “سَمَوَاتٌ” (*samawat*) would not only mean sky and heavens, but also everything that is in the universe which includes galaxies so far discovered and those yet to be discovered and beyond. In other words, this word includes everything there is to be found.

Where ever the Quran has used the phrase of “أَرْضٌ وَسَمَاءٌ” (*arz o sama-a*), it needs to seen in the context in which it appears e.g. whether it implies loftiness and lowliness, whether it is in regard to physical things or in respect of ranks, or social life within a society. More details have appeared under the heading (A-R-Zd).

The Quran says:

2:31	Adam has been taught the names of everything	وَعَلَّمَ آدَمَ الْأَسْمَاءَ كُلَّهَا
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Here *Adam* refers to all humanity or mankind. Also see under the heading (A-D-M). As mentioned earlier, knowing the names alone will do no good, until and unless you know what a thing is. As such, the meaning of the knowledge of names being given to *Adam* or man means that he has been given the potential and ability to discover and determine the characteristics of various elements and things in the universe. This is the reason the Quran declares that all the forces of the universe (the *Malaikah*) are within the reach and control of the man i.e. he has the potentials, attributes, and abilities to bring these to his use. The Quran does not differentiate this life from the next life when mentions these aspects of putting to the disposal of the human potentials. When man becomes aware of the law under which these forces of nature operate, all forces under that law become within his reach and are acchiveable. The Quran refers to both

parts of human life i.e. this physical existence and the life beyond death. It is upto us to explore both possibilities through the use of our intellect and reasoning. Therefore, a nation will become master of the universal forces according to the laws it becomes aware of. Further step is how to utilize those forces.

It has been said:

2:38	Any nation which will utilize the guidance in the Quran they will have no fear and no grief.	فَمَنْ تَبِعَ هُدَايَ فَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ
2:39	If a nation which masters the forces of the universe but utilizes these not for the benefit of the mankind then they will suffer the consequences of going against the Quranic guidance.	أُولَئِكَ أَصْحَابُ النَّارِ هُمْ فِيهَا خَالِدُونَ

What should be nation called then it neither masters the forces of the universe nor utilizes these forces as per the laws of God? A western doctor has written something very interesting as per his perception.

“Adam was made responsible for characterising things. This was a very huge responsibility, because the things whose characteristics and properties are not known remain undetermined and undefined. And if inaccurate characteristics are given to things, the results can be very harmful”. {Dr. M.L. Tyler in “*Homeo, drug pictures*” (preface)}.

This too signifies that acquiring knowledge about physical laws is a sign of being human. The Quran says that those whom you think are your gods (other than the real God) are:

12:40	Simply some names which you and your forefathers have fabricated	أَسْمَاءٌ سَمَّيْتُمُوهَا أَنْتُمْ وَأَبَاؤُكُمْ
12:40	Allah has not provided any support for this (not evidence and fact based)	مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ بِهَا مِنْ سُلْطَانٍ

The big religious structures which have been erected from the past or those being erected now have no real significance other than the names given to them. These don't solve any human problems and issues except being used to project some mortals in high position to impress fellow mortals to influence them. The Quranic guidance explains the purpose of each human and thus takes away all the paraphernalia associated with the power, religious stature or wealth and helps us to look through to the reality. The right place of things is that which has been designated by Allah's law. His laws operate smoothly in the outer universe, and in the human world, the divine revelation is the right source and guide to these laws. Everything else may have a big name but gets exposed when analysed in the light of the guidance provided in the Quran.

S-N-B-L

س ن ب ل

“السُّنْبُلُ” (*as- sumbul*): An ear of grain, bunch of ears Singular is “السُّنْبُلَةُ” (*as-sumbulah*) as used in 2:261. Plurals are “سُنَابِلُ” (*sanabil*) and “سُنْبَلَاتُ” (*sunbalat*)
 “قَدْ سُنْبِلَ الزَّرْعُ” (*qad sanbalaz zar-a*): corn grew ears {T}. This word is used to mean grain, not fruit.

“السَّنَدُ” (*as-sanad*): a thing which is used for support.

“سَنَدَ إِلَيْهِ” (*sanada ilaihi*), “يَسْنُدُ” (*yasnud*): he leaned (e.g. against a support) {T}.

“سَنَدَ الشَّيْءَ” (*sanadash shaiyi*): he supported the thing and made it strong.

“السَّنَدُ” (*as-sanad*): high mountain facing you .

“السَّنْدَانُ” (*as-sandaan*): an ironsmith’s anvil over which heated iron is rested (to soften it) and then beaten (into a particular shape) {M}.

“السَّنَدُ” (*as-sanad*): a sort of sheet that was made in Yemen.

“سَنَدَ الرَّجُلُ” (*sanadar rajul*): man put a cloth sheet over him {T}.

The Quran says that the hypocrites are like “خُشْبٌ مُسْنَدٌ” (*khushboon musannadah*) in 63:4, that is, they are like sticks which are leaning against the wall. It can also mean that they are like sticks which are wrapped up in human clothing . If we take the first meaning which will mean, a hypocrite is never self-confident and is always seeking support of others for his hypocrisy.

If we take the later meaning then it will mean a hypocrite is one thing inside and something else outside. Their exterior is always very appealing to people making use of various clothing, but deprived of all human qualities.

“سُنْدُسٌ” (*sundus*): silk of high quality (*Taj & Raghib*).

The Quran says:

18:31	Clothes of green silk	ثِيَابًا خَضِرًا مِنْ سُنْدُسٍ
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“السَّنَامُ” (*as-sanaam*): camel’s hump.

“السَّيْمُ مِنَ النَّبْتِ” (*as-simu minan nabt*): a tall plant which has flowered or grown ears.

“سَنَمَ الْإِنَاءُ تَسْنِيماً” (*sannamal ina-a tasneema*): he filled the utensil or pot – filling to the extent that whatever is put into it (e.g. grain) rose above the edges.

“تَسَنَّمَ الْخَاءُطُ” (*tasannamal ha-it*): he climbed the wall.

“اَسْنَمَتِ النَّارُ” (*asnamatin naar*): the flames of the fire rose high.

“سَنَامُ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*sanaamu kulli shaiyin*): the best or highest part of something {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means loftiness and height.

The Quran has said about “تَسْنِيمٌ” (*tasneem*) which has been explained further by saying:

83:28	a spring out of which the righteous ones drink	عَيْنًا يَشْرَبُ بِهَا الْمُقَرَّبُونَ
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This has the connotation of loftiness. That is, life’s evolutionary stages, humanity’s heights in righteousness, full development of human abilities and enhancement of potentials.

“السِّنُّ” (*as-sinnu*): teeth {*T, M*} as in (5:45). Since the age of animals is determined by the number of teeth they have, it also means age.

“أَسَنَّ الرَّجُلُ” (*as-sannar rajul*): the man reached old age.

“السُّنَّةُ” (*as-sunnah*): face, the open and distinct part of the face. It also means path, manner, custom, law. Its plural is “سُنَنٌ” (*sunan*).

“سُنَنُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*sananat tareeq*), “سُنَنُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*sunanat tareeq*), “سُنَنُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*sinanat tareeq*). These words are not plural forms of “سُنَّةٌ” (*sunnah*) which is a separate word. This means open and distinct part of a path. This led to its meaning of manner, sect, routine, and law:

The Quran says:

17:77	you will find no change in our way (system, law):	وَلَا تَجِدُ لِسُنَّتِنَا تَحْوِيًا
35:43	now people appear to be waiting for whatever happened to the others to happen to them as well	فَيَلْ يَنْظُرُونَ إِلَّا سُنَّتَ الْأَوَّلِينَ
3:136	a lot of different systems and paths , and routines have passed before your time	قَدْ خَلَتْ مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ سُنَنٌ

Ibn Faris says it means for something to continue, and for things to appear comfortably one after another.

“سَنَّ الشَّيْءَ” (*sannash shaiyi*) means to make something easy or to facilitate it {*M*}.

“سَنَّ التُّرَابَ عَلَى وَجْهِ الْأَرْضِ” (*sannat turaaba ala wajhil arda*): spread the soil smoothly on the ground till it turned into a dam {*M*}.

Regarding the creation of man, the Quran says:

15:26	From putrefied mud	مِنْ حَمَاءٍ مَسْنُونٍ
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Lane (with different references) has written that “سَنَنْتُ الْحَجَرَ عَلَى الْحَجَرِ” (*sananatul hajara alal hajar*) means that I put a stone on stone and rubbed it (grounded it). Occasionally putting water and rubbing stone on stone produces a kind of putrified matter which is called “سَنِينٌ” (*saneen*). When it is allowed to remain for some time, it becomes hard {*L*}.

Some say that “مَسْنُونٌ” (*masnoon*) means wet and moist.

Abul heesham says that “سَنَّ الْمَاءَ” (*sannal maa-u*) means that water transformed {*T*}.

The Quran says that man was initially created from the soil. The soil which was mixed with water, i.e. life began with (inorganic & Organic) matter intermingling with water. When these two met and eons passed, there was a lot of metamorphosis in the matter and life began. This has been termed as “حَمَاءٌ مَسْنُونٌ” (*hama inn masnoon*). Note that it explains how life began physically, but this does not mean that life is the product of this matter.

The Quran's has declared:

35:43	There are no changes in the method of Allah	فَلَنْ يَجِدَ لِسُنَّتِ اللَّهِ تَبْدِيلًا
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This is an expression of a great fact, on which all scientific research rests, which is the basis of human living in the universe. Quran declared 1500 years ago that God's laws never change. Declaring such a fact is not the product of a human intellect. Humans have become aware of the concept of laws in the recent past . All scientific research is producing ever new results and we are becoming aware of the laws which never change. This understanding of these laws is giving us a new confidence in our functioning knowing fully well that these laws will never let us down and this has opened ever new spheres of scientific discoveries When man once understands the law made by God, he knows that these laws never change. Just like Allah's immutable laws are operating in the physical world and the universe, so are His laws working in the human world. He has fixed some rules for the rise and fall of nations, and these rules never

change. Any nation which follows these values will prosper and a nation which does not follow these values, will get destroyed.

This law based concept of God has brought a revolutionary change in the world. In the early human period man conceived God as a despot who did not follow any laws and values. For example He could get angry just like a human dictator or bestow rewards without any reason. Such a concept of God was became an object of fear lest He may become angry on a minor matter so man tried according to his own self-created belief and understanding to keep such a God happy with different offerings – the acts of worship.

The Quran made this revolutionary declaration that although God was all powerful and the highest authority, He had formulated laws for the physical universe, as well as for the human functioning sphere. And despite holding unlimited power, He has ordained that there will be no change in the laws He has formulated (no matter what happens).

So the decisions of human life too will be made, not whimsically, but according to His laws. That is, every human deed will produce results according to the laws framed by God and these are noted and explained in the Quran. For example the Quran declared: ‘Allah created the heavens and the earth for just ends, so that every self finds the recompense of what it does in life; and none is treated unjustly’ (45:22)

“وَلَنْ تَجِدَ لِسُنَّتِ اللَّهِ تَبْدِيلًا” (*walan tajida lisunnatil lahi tabdeela*): and His laws will never change.

God only acts according to His law this is a law which never changes – we have verified it through our research in the scientific field. This change in human thinking has helped to change the face of the earth and the Quran has declared that: ‘Soon will we show them Our signs in the furthest regions and in their own Self until it becomes manifest to them that this (The Quran) is the Truth....’ (41:53). Those who understand the Quran and its thinking need to make others aware of the reality explained in the Book. This will help to bring change in the human thinking so that we can reduce the mutual conflicts and use this life to develop our self within the domain of the permanent values.

S-N-He س ن ه

	food and drink were spoiled or deteriorated	سَنِةُ الطَّعَامِ وَالشَّرَابِ سَنَاءً وَتَسَنَاءً
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“السَّهْنُ” (*as-sanahu*): to petrify, something to change due to passage of time. This word is used when bread becomes stale and drinks become stale and deteriorate.

“طَعَامٌ سَنِ” (*tyaamu sanehun*): spoilt food.

“خُبْزٌ مُتَسَنٌ” (*khubzun mutasannehun*): stale or spoiled bread.

The Quran says:

2:259	It was not spoiled	أَمْ يَتَسَنَّهُ
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Even after passage of so much time, it did not metamorphose or change $\{T, M\}$.

Ibn Faris says that the meaning of “سَنَهُ” (*sanah*) is to depend on time.

“سَنَهَاتِ النَّخْلَةِ” (*sanahatin nakhlah*): many years passed on the date palm.

Most scholars are of the opinion that “سَنَهُ” (*sanah*) meaning of years has been derived from this root, but we have put “سَنَهُ” (*sanah*) and its derivatives under heading (S-N-W).

“السَّنَةُ” (*as-sanah*) means years (its plurals are “سَنَوَاتٌ” (*sanawat*), “سِنُونٌ” (*sinoon*) and “سِنِينَ” (*sineen*). There is some difference of opinion about its root. One school of thought says that its root is (S-N-H) because the Arabs say “سَانَهُتُ فُلَانًا” (*saanahu fulana*) which means that I cut a deal with him on yearly rate.

Ibn Faris says the real meaning of “سَنَةٌ” (*sanah*) is dependent on a period of time.

“سَنَهَاتِ النَّخْلَةِ” (*sanahatan nakhlah*): many years passed on the date palm. A second opinion says that its root is “سَنُو” (*sano*) from which “يَسْنُو” (*yasnu*) has been derived, which means to go round and round a well.

“السَّانِيَةُ” (*as-saaniyah*) means an animal which is made to go round and round a well in order to bring water out .

“السَّنَةُ” (*as-sanah*) means one orbit of the sun. This is also called “دَارٌ” (*daar*), and since this orbit takes a full year, therefore “السَّنَةُ” (*as-sinah*) means one year.

“السَّنَةُ” (*as-sanah*) is a solar year while “الْعَامُ” (*al-a'am*) is a lunar year.

“السَّنَةُ” (*as-sanah*) also means a year when there is drought and intensity, and “الْعَامُ” (*al-a'am*) is a year when there is prosperity and good harvest .

29:14	And he lived fifty less than one thousand years among his people	فَلَبِثَ فِيهِمْ أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ إِلَّا خَمْسِينَ عَامًا
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Here “عَامًا” (*a'ama*) is the period without hardships and “سَنَةٌ” (*sanah*) is the period when there were hardships.

Lane says “سَنَةٌ” (*sanah*) also means crop of which there are four harvest in a year.

“أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ” (*alfa sanatin*) means two hundred fifty years, and “عَامٌ” (*a'am*) is one full year. So if “خَمْسِينَ عَامًا” (*khamseen aama*) are taken out from it, it leaves us with two hundred years, which could be a man's age. But these are all conjectures. When more historical facts come forth it will become clear what the Quran meant to say that *Nooh* lived fifty less than one thousand years among his people (29:14). Some say this is his period of messenger-hood, which commenced from the the era of an earlier messenger of Allah.

“سَنَاءٌ” (*sannah*) or “تَسْنِيَةٌ” (*tasniah*): opened it, facilitated it, made it easy {*T, M, R*}.

“السَّنَى” (*as-sana*) means light.

“السَّنَاءُ” (*as-sana-u*) and “السَّنَى” (*as-sana*) means loftiness and high stature.

The Quran says:

24:43	The dazzle of the lightning nearly blinded	يَكَادُ سَنَا بَرْقِهِ يَذْهَبُ بِالْأَبْصَارِ
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Here “سَنَا” (*sana*) means dazzling light.

Ibn Faris says it basically means stature and loftiness.

“سَهْرَ” (*sahir*), “يَسْهَرُ” (*yasher*), “سَهْرًا” (*sahara*): to be awake (at night).
 “سَاهِرٌ” (*saahir*): one who wakes up at night, remaining awake at night {*T, M, R*}.
 “السَّاهِرَةُ” (*as-saahirah*): the upper part of the earth, the face of earth, or that part of the earth on which human beings live, or which is ‘alive’ because of them.

The Quran says:

79:14	There will be eternal life after the renaissance (life after death),	فَإِذَا هُمْ بِالسَّاهِرَةِ
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It also means continuously in a state of awakening, or speed in development because “أَرْضُ السَّاهِرَةِ” (*ardun saahirah*) is a land which grows plants very quickly {*T*}.

Since the state of life after death is incomprehensible to us, therefore the Quran relates those in terms of metaphors and examples only. Men having insight can have a faint glimpse at a inner reflection level of what it is meant by those examples and metaphors. Understanding more than this is not possible in this life—at least that is the level of understanding at the beginning of the 21st century. As further research is carried out on the Quranic message, more may be discovered by the later generations.

In Syrian language “السَّاهُورُ” (*as-saahoor*) means the same as “الْقَمَرُ” (*al-qamar*) or the moon {*F*}, {*Kitab-ul-Ashfaq*}. In pure Arabic it means lunar eclipse {*Lane*}.

“السَّهْلُ” (*as-sahal*), “السَّهْلُ” (*as-sahil*): a soft thing.
 “السَّهْلُ مِنَ الْأَرْضِ” (*as-sahal minal arz*): soft ground. Plural is “سُهُولٌ” (*suhul*) {*T*}.

The Quran says:

7:74	you build palaces on levelled and soft ground	تَتَّحِدُونَ مِنْ سُهُولِهَا قُصُورًا
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“سَهْمَاسٌ” (*sahumas*): part. Its fundamental meaning is of an arrow which was used for balloting to apportion shares or to divide. It also means a corridor in a house.
 “السُّهَامُ” (*as-suhaam*): to become weak and change colour. It also means a camel disease in which they feel hot and thirsty.
 “السُّهُومُ” (*as-suhoom*): to be harsh due to some stress or worry.
 “سَاهَمَ الْقَوْمُ” (*saahamal qaum*): he balloted with the nation {*T, M, R*}.
 It also means to compete in archery, as well as to try overpowering each other.

The Quran says in reference to the story of *Yunus*:

37:141	he balloted along with the others (traditional translation)	فَسَاهَمَ
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This verse is taken as part of a story of Yunus where he was in a boat and there was a ballot to ask one to leave the boat to lighten its load. However, this interpretation does not fit here and as explained later, more plausible meanings are taken for this term.

Allah has said that *Yunus* contested our laws (went against them or did not follow them) and it was his mistake.

37:141	(as a consequence) he slipped	فَكَانَ مِنَ الْمُدْحَضِينَ
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Yunus got frustrated with the people of his nation and hastened in making a decision prior to receiving clear signs from Allah. . This hastening and leaving his people resulted in his getting in trouble in the water; however, he managed to come back to his people as explained in the Quran.

S-He-W س ه و

“سَهَوُ” (*sahw*), “غَفْلَةٌ” (*ghaflah*) and “نِسْيَانٌ” (*nisyaan*) are all of the same meaning, but some say that “سَهَوُ” (*sahw*) is slight neglect of something present in the human memory, and “نِسْيَانٌ” (*nisyaan*) is for something to go completely out of memory.

Ibn al-Asseer says that “سَهَوُ الشَّيْءِ” (*saha fish shaiyi*) means to give something up due to unawareness, and “سَهَاعَنُ” (*saha unhu*) means to give something up knowingly {T, R, M}.

“السَّهْوُ” (*as-sahw*): for something to be motionless and soft.

“السَّهْوَةُ” (*as-sahwah*): a bow which is easily stretched {T, R, M}.

Ibn Faris says most of the meanings of this word are connected with neglect and peace.

“جَاءَ سَهْوًا رَهِبًا” (*ja'an rahwan rahwa*): he came very peacefully.

The Quran says:

51:11	They are engaged in their doings and are unaware of the reality	هُمْ فِي غَمْرَةٍ سَاهُونَ
107:5	They are neglectful of their duties	الَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ
9:54	They are unaware of the reality of <i>salaah</i>	وَلَا يَأْتُونَ الصَّلَاةَ
107:6	and only believe in its physical form	الَّذِينَ هُمْ يُرَآؤُونَ

Because these can be very easily carried out and can gain respect in society .through visible worship acts

S-W-A س و أ

“سَاءَ” (*sa-ahu*), “يُسُوءُ” (*yasu-uhu*): to say something to someone which is unpleasant.

“سَاءَ الشَّيْءُ” (*sa-ush shaiyi*): something bad happened.

“أَسَاءَ” (*asa-a*), “يُسِيئُ” (*yu-see*): to do something bad, to create imbalance and inequality, to create chaos and deterioration. It is the opposite of “أَحْسَنَ” (*ahsan*).

“السَّيِّئَةُ” (*as-sabeelah*): life's unpleasantness, problems in life {T}.

This is the opposite of “سَيِّئَةٌ” (*hasanah*) which means to give something complete balance and hence “سَيِّئَةٌ” (*sayyye-atah*) means imbalance. As such, “سَوَاءٌ” (*sau-u*) means harm, chaos, and annihilation {T}, {*Latif-ul-Lugha*}. “حَسَنَةٌ” (*hasanah*) also means striking balance in actions and deeds “سَيِّئَةٌ” (*sayyye-atah*) being opposite would mean exaggeration, disturbing the balance, going to extremes {T}.

“مَسَاوِي” (*masaawi*): unpleasant things, faults {T} {*Latif-ul-Lugha*}.

Also see heading (H-S-N).

“السَّوْءُ” (*as-sau-ah*): bad nature, bad thing or work, any talk or deed which if revealed will cause shame. It also means the male and female genitalia {T}. Plural is “سَوَاتٌ” (*saw'aat*) as in (7:20, 7:26).

The Quran says “سَيِّئَةٌ” (*sayyi-atah*) against “سَيِّئَةٌ” (*hasanah*) at several places, as in (7:131), 3:119 etc. It also uses “اِقْتِصَادٌ” (*saa-a*) against “اِقْتِصَادٌ” (*iqtesaad*) which means striking balance (5:66).

To mean to be sad or have tribulations “سَيِّئٌ بِهِمْ” (*siya behim*) has been used in (11:77). The effects of the righteous living is beauty and goodness in a society. In a society based on the permanent values, both human personality and society are balanced, and each member gets all the pleasantries of life. Acting against this way creates imbalance and as a consequence unpleasantness is created. This is why the Quran has said that people who live these opposing lifestyles can never be the same (40:58). The question that arises here is that if the balance of a society has gone awry, then what do we do to set it right?

The Quran says:

23:96	if you do righteous deeds, the imbalance within a society will (gradually) go away	إِذْفَعُ بِالَّتِي هِيَ أَحْسَنُ السَّيِّئِ
11:114	Indeed the good deeds remove the evil deeds	إِنَّ الْحَسَنَاتِ يُذْهِبْنَ السَّيِّئَاتِ

Surah *Al-Momineen* says that one of the characteristics of a true believer is:

13:22 25:54	They remove evil by virtue	يَذَرُهُ وَنَ بِالْحَسَنِ السَّيِّئِ
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This does not mean that the Quran teaches us to present the other cheek if one is slapped or if someone takes off your coat (i.e. robs it forcibly), then you take off your shirt for him too. Such teachings only encourage the criminals. The Quran directs us to enforce justice which requires that steps to be taken to prevent crimes in a society and to punish criminals taking into account all circumstances. It also asks us to look at the causes of the crimes and to have a programme in place to rehabilitate those who are willing to reform themselves.

For example the Quran declares:

42:40 10:27	The punishment should always be commensurate to the crime,	حَزَاؤُ اسَّيِّئَةٍ مِّثْلُهَا
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No crime should have more punishment than what it deserves – as noted earlier, all circumstances should be taken into account. Also where reform can be expected, forgiveness is advocated. This verse makes it clear that evil should not be returned with evil. Each member of the society should be made aware of the Law of requital i.e. what we sow so shall we reap.

41:27	verily we will punish them severely for the deeds they have committed	وَلَنَجْزِيَنَّهُمْ أَشْرَ الَّذِي كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ
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The foregoing explains how the Quran teaches to create balance in our personality and in a society at large.

Suw'a سُدُوع

It was the name of an idol during the reign of *Nooh* (71:23). People of Arabia were well aware of this name. The tribe of *Banu Hazeel* used to worship an idol of this name.

S-W-D س و د

“الْأَسْوَدُ” (*al-aswad*) is the opposite of “الْبَيْضُ” (*abyaz*), which means black. Plural is “سُودٌ” (*suud*) as in (35:27).

“السَّوْدُ” (*iswad*), “يَسْوَدُ” (*yaswad*): it became black:

“السَّوَادُ” (*as-sawaad*): darkness, blackness, great wealth, the villages around a city, a large number, common folk, a big part of the nation.

“السَّائِدُ” (*as-saa'id*): a leader of a smaller stature than “سَيِّدٌ” (*syed*) {T}.

“السَّيِّدُ” (*as-syed*): leader, or one who has a big party, lord, or husband {T}.

“السِّيَادَةُ” (*as-siyaadah*): leadership.

“الْأَسْوَدُ مِنَ الْقَوْمِ” (*al aswad minal qaum*): the most powerful and prominent man in a nation, a patron of a nation {T}.

“الْأَيَّامُ الْمَسْوَدَةُ” (*al ayyamal muswada*): days of ill-being and pain {M}.

Raghib says “إِبْيَضَاضُ الْوَجْهِ” (*ibyidadul wujuh*) means happiness and pleasure and “إِسْوَادُ الْوَجْهِ” (*ibswidadul wujuh*) means sorrow and pain {R}. Also see heading (B-Y-Zd).

“سَيِّدٌ” (*sayyeda*) meaning leader or head – this has been used by the Quran in (3:38). It means a man of respect, and meaning as a husband, has been used in (12:25); here it has been referred to a man in Egypt who was not only a husband, but was a leading figure as well. The Quran has not used it to mean an ordinary husband.

The Quran says:

16:58	black, dark, or sorrowful	وَجْهٌ مُسْوَدًّا
3:105	faces to blacken (be demeaned)	تَسْوُدُ وُجُوهُ

It means when a face turns 'black', out of tribulation and trouble as an example. Against this the word used is (*tabyaz*) which means to be white meaning to be honoured.

S-W-R

س و ر

“سَارٌ” (*saar*), “يَسُورُ” (*yasoor*), “سَوْرَةٌ” (*saurah*): to accost or attack someone.

“سُرْتُ الْحَائِطِ وَتَسَوَّرْتُهُ” (*surt ul-haa-ita wa tasawwaratuh*): I climbed the wall.

“السُّورُ” (*as-soor*): a city in which one takes sanctuary. It also means loftiness, respect and honour.

“سَوْرَةُ السُّلْطَانِ” (*saoratus sultan*): a king's grandeur, respect etc.

“السَّوَارُ” (*as-siwaar*): a bracelet which was at that time a sign of honour and stature. “أَسَاوِيرُ” (*asaawir*) is its plural form.

“الْأَسْوَارُ” (*al-uswaar*) or “الْإِسْوَارُ” (*al-aswaar*): cavalry commander. It also means a very good archer and horseman {T}.

Ibn Faris has said that “الْإِسْوَارُ” (*al-iswaar*) is not an Arabic word.

“السُّورَةُ” (*as-surah*) means rank and stature, respect, loftiness. It also means a building which rises majestically towards the sky {M}.

Many reasons are quoted about the Quranic chapters called “سُورَةٌ” (*surah*). Some think that these are called so because they contain higher level thoughts. Others think that the earlier chapters work as a stepping stone for the following chapters.. Still others say that since the chapters were revealed by stages and they all constitute the “building” of the Quran, therefore they are called “سُورَةٌ” (*surah*). Some say that they are called so because they are safe within the Quran, like a man seeking sanctuary is safe in a city which has provided protection {T}. A sign is also called a “سُورَةٌ” (*surah*) {M}.

“سُوْرٌ” (*soor*) also means strong, well-built camels of high breed {T}.

In the Quran itself, it has meant Quranic chapters (2:23) and as a sign of leadership. It has also come to mean hand bracelet in (35:33), (18:31) and (76:21).

Surah *Saad* says:

38:21	when they climbed over the wall into the porch.	إِذْ تَسَوَّروا الْمِحْرَابَ
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The bracelets mentioned in heavenly society are referring towards power, grandeur and loftiness which believers will enjoy there (18:41). The Quran says that this is an allegory of the real thing. We cannot comprehend their reality with our present level of consciousness. See heading (J-N-N).

Ibn Faris says that “السَّوْطُ” (*as-saut*) basically means to mix things with other things. Mixing to confuse things as these lose their true identity. *Ibn Faris* has noted these meanings.

“السَّوْطُ” (*as-saut*) also means to whip because it mixes the skin with blood, or because it penetrates the skin or perhaps because the whip itself is woven by twisting different strands of leather. The plural is “أَسْوَاتُ” (*aswaat*).

Although it means to whip, the Arabs meant that any painful punishment was “سَوْطٌ عَذَابٍ” (*as-sauta azaab*), or punishing whip.

Muheet and *Raghib* think that “سَوْطٌ عَذَابٍ” (*sauta azaab*), as in (89:12) means different kinds of punishments, mixed together {T, R, M}.

Ibn Faris says “سَوْطٌ عَذَابٍ” (*sauta azaa*) means a part of punishment.

S-W(Y)-Ain

س و (ى) ع

“سَاعٌ” (*saa-a*), “يَسُوعٌ” (*yasoo*)

Muheet says that this root's real meaning is destruction, decline, and downfall {T}.

“سَاعَ الشَّيْءِ” (*sa-ash shaiyi*) means that a thing was wasted.

“هُوَ ضَاعَ سَاءً” (*huwa zaa-i-un saa-ih*): he is to be wasted and annihilated.

“فَاقَتْ مِيسْيَاغٌ” (*faqatun misyaun*): a she camel which leaves her young one unprotected in the jungle where wild animals may kill it.

“أَسَاعَ” (*asa-a*): left it unprotected and let it go waste.

“رَجُلٌ مُسِيْعٌ” (*rajulun muse'un*) and “مِيسْيَاغٌ لِلْمَالِ” (*mesa'u lilmaal*): a man who wastes his wealth.

“السَّيْعُ” (*as-sayyi'u*): water that flows on the ground.

“سَاعَ الْمَاءِ وَالْشَّرَابِ” (*saa-al maa-u wa ash-sharaab*): water and wine fell to the ground and started flowing.

“تَسَيَّعَ الْبَقْلُ” (*tasayyi-al baql*): the vegetables began to dry {T}.

“أَسْوَعَ” (*aswa*): he transferred from one time frame to another, or went back one moment or stage {T}.

“سَوْعٌ مِنَ اللَّيْلِ” (*sau un minal lail*): a peaceful part of the night.

“السَّاعَةُ” (*as-saa-ah*): portion of a time which passes continuously and the time which is lost.

Ibn Faris says it means to pass on a continuous basis.

It also means tough time, rivalry, and distance

“السَّاعَةُ” (*as-saa'h*): those who are killed {T}.

The Quran has used the word “السَّاعَةُ” (*as-sa'h*) extensively. The Quran repeatedly warns those who are on the wrong path that such a choice leads only to destruction and loss. It warns that if you do not change your ways then you will be destroyed as consequence of your actions. This is known as “إِنْذَارٌ” (*inzaar*) i.e. giving warning of the consequences of one's actions. These people do not heed this, and stick to their ways. Their wrong deeds keep piling up negative results until the time arrives when these results that are being compiled quietly but surely, become evident and the people are destroyed. This is called “السَّاعَةُ” (*as-saa'h*), or the time of manifestation of the results. This change does not come at once, but is brewed for a long time. Despite this, it does make its appearance in a way that those who are unaware of its reality think that it has come upon them suddenly. Since this revolution mostly takes place through the hands of those who rise in the support of the truth -, this “السَّاعَةُ” (*as-saa'h*) is in a way the last battle

between good and evil, in which the forces of evil are defeated and destroyed. In short, the meaning of “السَّاعَةُ” (*as-saa’h*) would be the manifestation of the result of deeds.

Surah *Taha* says that Allah informed *Moosa* in detail about how far the pharaoh’s rebelliousness had gone, and then told him what he had to do. It is then said:

20:15	Know that the time for the last battle between good and evil has come.	إِنَّ السَّاعَةَ آتِيَةٌ
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It means that it will come for sure. The pharaoh cannot be left to do as he pleases. The revolution is bound to come. Likewise the last Messenger (*pbuh*) was also told several times in the Quran:

15:85	the time for the last revolution is arriving	إِنَّ السَّاعَةَ لَا تَبِيَّةَ
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Here it means that the revolution will definitely come and the opponents will be destroyed. The battle between truth and falsehood has been going on, on a small scale, and continues to do so. But it appears from the study of the Quran that as time moves ahead and the truths become revealed, there will be a big clash between the universal concept of meeting human basic needs and those who pursue selfish interests - , after which the earth will be illuminated by the universal concept of sustenance for all human beings as noted in (39:69). . This is the great “السَّاعَةُ” (*as-saa’h*) pointing to a momentous change in the world and predicted by the Quran (89:22).

As per the Quran the human life does not end with death, nor do the results of deeds end with death. Thus in the life hereafter, results too have been called “السَّاعَةُ” (*as-saa’h*). The context in which the term is used can be deduced from the study of the Quran i.e. whether referred to the present life to the life in the hereafter.

The cumulative effects of human actions take time to materialise, therefore the effects of the wrong path adopted by various nations take time to show their results. The Quran invites us to study the history from this aspect and see the consequences of following the wrong values.

In Surah *Al-Airaaf* the Quran declares:

7:187	These people ask you as to when will that time of reckoning, with which you try to frighten us, will come? Tell them, only Allah knows. Nobody but Allah will reveal it at its time	يَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ السَّاعَةِ أَيَّانَ مُرْسِلُهَا- قُلْ إِنَّمَا عِلْمُهَا عِنْدَ رَبِّي- لَا يُجَلِّئُهَا لِوَفْعَتِهَا إِلَّا هُوَ
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Also see 79:42-44.

At another place it is said:

33:63	people ask you about the time of reckoning, tell them only God knows about it, and what do you know, that moment may be near	يَسْأَلُكَ النَّاسُ عَنِ السَّاعَةِ- قُلْ إِنَّمَا عِلْمُهَا عِنْدَ اللَّهِ- وَمَا يُذَرِّكَ لَعَلَّ السَّاعَةَ تَكُونُ قَرِيبًا
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At other places too it is said that only God knows when that moment will come (see 41:47, 43:85 and 31:34)

The Quran refers to the Bani Israel as an example to illustrate the rise and fall of nations from the history. The Bani Israel had messengers of Allah for about 1500 years and enjoyed the prosperity until they followed the revealed permanent values. However, when they went against these values, they suffered the consequences.

The last was *Isa* who told them clearly that if they do not reform their ways, then the power and prosperity will be taken away from them as per Allah’s laws. But the reply they gave *Isa* is a historical fact and after that the time for revolution did come and the nation’s grandeur and prosperity was taken away from them.

It is said about *Isa* in the Quran:

43:61	His advent was to make the people aware of the great moment of truth.	وَ إِنَّهُ لَعِلْمٌ لِلْسَّاعَةِ
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Also see 3:46-55, 43:63-66.

If the pronoun “إِنَّهٗ” (*innahu*) is taken to refer to the Quran, then the verse would mean that this Quran tells about the great revolution which is imminent.

S-W-Gh س و غ

“سَاغَ الشَّرَابُ” (*saghas sharaab*), “يَسُوغُ” (*vasoogh*), “سَوَّغًا” (*saugha*): for a drink to go down the throat easily.

“سَاغَ الطَّعَامُ” (*saaghat tu-aam*): the food went down the throat easily.

“السَّوَّاعُ” (*as-siwagh*): that which helps in getting something down the throat.

“شَرَابٌ سَاءٌ” (*sharabun saa-igh*): pleasant drink which can easily be swallowed.

“طَعَامٌ سَيِّغٌ” (*tu-aamun sayyigh*): delightful food.

“سَاغَ النَّهَارُ” (*saaghun nahar*): the day passed easily or peacefully {T, R, M}.

The Quran says about the hell dweller:

14:17	he will swallow it indeed but with difficulty	يَتَجَرَّعُهُ وَلَا يَكَادُ يُسَبِّغُهُ
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For details see heading (J-R-Ain).

Surah *An-Nahal* says about milk:

16:66	it is very pleasant for whosoever drinks it (it is easily swallowed)	سَائِغًا لِلشَّارِبِينَ
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Sauf سَوْفَ

“سَوْفَ” (*sauf*) is used like “سَنَ” (*seen*) for indication of some event taking place in the near future, soon.

Some say that “سَنَ” (*seen*) is used for the near future, while “سَوْفَ” (*sauf*) for distant future, but this is not a rule. Sometimes “لَ” (*laam*) comes ahead of “سَوْفَ” (*sauf*) to put stress on what is being said :

93:5	And your Rabb will endow you with so much that you will become satisfied (it will be according to your wish).	وَلَسَوْفَ يُعْطِيكَ رَبُّكَ فَتَرْضَىٰ
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S-W-Q س و ق

“السَّاقُ” (*as-saaq*): the calf (upper part) of a leg. The plural is “سَوَقٌ” (*suuq*) as in (38:33.)

“السَّاقُ” (*as-saaq*) also means the trunk of a tree. Its plural is “سَوَقٌ” (*suuq*) as well, as in (48:29). But when Arabs relate something with stress or intensity, they link it with “سَاقٍ” (*saaq*) {T, R, M}. See heading (K-Sh-F) where it has been described in detail.

The Quran says:

68:42	The day that the shin will be laid bare	يَوْمَ يُكْشَفُ عَنْ سَاقٍ
75:29	And one leg will be joined with another	وَالْتَقَّتِ السَّاقُ بِالسَّاقِ
27:44	And she uncovered her legs	كَشَفَتْ عَنْ سَاقَيْهَا

In all the above, the connotation is of intensity.

“سَاقٍ” (*saaqa*): to drive the animals from behind {T, R, M} as in 7:57.

“فَادَ” (*qaada*) means to pull animals from the front.

“سَاعِقٌ” (*saa-iq*): one who drives (animals) {T, R, M} (50:21).

“مَسَاقٍ” (*masaaq*): place to drive animals

“السُّوقُ” (*as-sooq*): marketplace, or a place where people bring their animals for sale. Plural is “أَسْوَاقٌ” (*aswaq*)

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan has written that (S-W-Q) connote intensity and gathering.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to drive.

“السَّاقُاسُ” (*as-saaq*) also means calf of leg because it supports the walker.

“تَسْوِيلٌ” (*tasweel*): to make something to be so attractive (usually something bad) that one is attracted to it {T}, {M}, {*Al-ilm-ul-akhlaq*}. It also means to turn some something bad to good {T, R}.

Surah Yusuf says:

12:18	This is something your desires have made look good to you	بَلْ سَوَّلَتْ لَكُمْ أَنْفُسُكُمْ أَمْرًا
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Some say that it is from “سَوَّلَ” (*suul*) which means a desire which decks out something bad as good.

Surah *Muhammad* says:

27:25	Their desires made it look good to them (and in this way misled them)	الشَّيْطَانُ سَوَّلَ لَهُمْ
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In surah *Taha* the *Saamri* says:

20:96	in this way, my heart (mind) made it look good to me	وَكَذَٰلِكَ سَوَّلْتُ لِي نَفْسِي
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“سَوَّمَ” (*saum*) means to go out in search of something. The meaning is compound i.e. to go and search. Sometimes only the first meaning is taken, like “سَامَ الْإِبِلَ” (*sama al-ibl*) which means that camels went for grazing, or camels were let free to graze. At other times only the second meaning prevails, like “يَسْؤُمُونَكَ” (*yasumoonakum su-ul azaab*) in (2:49) which means that they (bad) used to be looking for punishment to come to you (good). To treat others cruelly, to create difficulties deliberately.

“سَامَتِ الطَّيْرُ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*saamatit tair alash shaiyi*): The bird kept hovering over it {T, M}.

“سَامَ فَلَانًا الْأَمْرَ” (*sama fulanal amr*): hurt him with something, made something must for him {T, M}.

“أَسَامَ الْإِبِلَ” (*asamal ibl*): left the camels to graze.

“السُّومَةُ” (*as-suma*), “السَّيْمَةُ” (*as-seemah*), “السَّيْمَاءُ” (*as-seema-a*): sign, mark.

“سَوَّمَ الْفَرَسَ تَسْوِيمًا” (*saumul farsa tusma*): branded the horse.

“سَوَّمَ فَلَانًا” (*sawwama fulanan*): let him go free.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* calls the *malaika* which are used to punish as “مُسَوِّمِينَ” (*musawwameen*) in (3:124).

The Quran says:

51:33	Those stones under Allah's law were earmarked to do the job	لُتَرْسِلَ عَلَيْهِمْ حِجَارَةً مِنْ طِينٍ مُسَوَّمَةً
3:14	And branded horses (horses which have been left to graze)	وَالْحَيْلِ الْمُسَوَّمَةِ
16:10	that in which you graze your cattle (the grazing fields)	وَمِنْهُ شَجَرٌ فِيهِ تُسِيمُونَ
48:29	Signs (marks) on their faces	سِيمَاهُمْ فِي وُجُوهِهِمْ

“إِسْتَوَاءٌ” (*istiwa*) means for something to be perfectly balanced in itself, or for something to have its forces in the right places in the right proportion, and for it to have reached the peak of its development {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it means solidarity and the balance between two things.

“إِسْتَوَى الرَّجُلُ” (*istawar rajul*): he reached his prime.

The Quran has described “إِسْتَوَى” (*istawa*) by saying “بَلَغَ أَشُدَّهُ” (*balagha ashud dah*) in (28:14). Likewise in “إِسْتَوَى عَلَى سُوْقِهِ” (*istawa ala suuqehi*) in (48:49) the meaning is clear i.e. for plants to stand upright on their stems.

“الْأَسْوَى” (*as-sawiyyu*) means which is safe from any exaggeration and in perfect proportion {*T, M*}.

“الْصِّرَاطُ السَّوِيُّ” (*as-siraatus sawiyyu*) means balanced path (20:135).

“رَجُلٌ سَوِيٌّ” (*rajulun sawiyyu*): a man whose morals and manners are immaculate.

That is, he has good figure and has balanced personality {*T*}.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:17	Then he assumed for her likeness a well-balanced man	فَتَمَثَّلَ لَهَا بَشَرًا سَوِيًّا
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“صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ” (*siraatim mustaqeemin*) has come against “مُكِبًّا عَلَى وَجْهِهِ” (*mukibban ala wajhihi*) in 67:22.

“سَوَّاهُ تَسْوِيَةً” (*sawwahu taswiyatah*) and “أَسْوَاهُ” (*aswah*) mean balanced him, made him balanced, smoothed him {*T*}.

Raghib says it also means to make according to what sagacity demands e.g. meeting the demands of human wisdom, the requirements to run human affairs as per the permanent values.

2:29	made them with the right balance	فَسَوَّيْنَاهُمْ سَوَاءً وَجَعَلْنَاهُمْ قُلُوبًا وَاحِدَةً
82:7	Allah is he who created and made you of the right proportion and balance as was needed	الَّذِي خَلَقَكَ فَسَوَّاكَ فَعَدَلَكَ

“إِسْتَوَى إِلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*istaa alash shaiyi*): to arrive at some conclusion through individual thinking, or to intend to do something, or to be attentive to it {*T, M*}.

“إِسْتَوَى عَلَى” (*istawa ala*) has the connotation of overpowering and control {*R*}.

The Quran says:

43:13	That you may sit firmly on their backs	لِيَسْتَوِيَ عَلَى ظُهُورِهِ
23:28	to sit tight (on an animal meant for riding, or on a boat)	لِيَسْتَوِيَتْ عَلَى الْفُلِكِ

For Allah becoming “إِسْتَوَى” (*istawa*) on His throne, see the heading (Ain-R-Sh).

“سَوَاءٌ” (*sawa-un*) means for two things to be equal to each other.

“سَوَاءٌ زَيْدٌ وَعَمْرُو” (*sawa-un zaidu wa um-run*): Zaid and Umru are of the same rank, are equals.

“إِسْتَوَيْتَا” (*istawayta*) and “تَسَاوَيْتَا” (*tasawayta*): for two things to be like each other, or similar.

“سَاوَيْتُ بَيْنَهُمَا مِثْلًا” (*saawaitu bainahuma musaawah*): I made one equal to the other.

“سَوَاءٌ” (*sawa-un*) also means justice.

“سَوَّيْتُ بَيْنَهُمَا” (*sawwatahu behi*), or “سَوَّيْتُ بَيْنَهُمَا” (*sawwaitu bainahuma*) means I did justice between those two.

“فَقُلْ أَذْنُكُمْ عَلَى سَوَاءٍ” (*fanbiz ahihim ala sawa-inn*): I have told you about all things on equal account (21:109).

The Quran says:

41:10	The earth should be available for use to all on equal basis	سَوَاءٌ لِلنَّاسِ إِلَهُ
20:58	Both of us will have to follow these conditions (You and I will be in the same position)	مَكَانًا سَوًى

Raghib says “مَكَانٌ سَوًى” (*makanun suwa*) means a point which is equidistant from both sides.

Ibn saidah writes that(*suwa*) means the place which has pointers so that people can find their way {T}.

“سَوًى” (*as-sawa-u*) means the middle or centre of a thing.

“سَوَاءُ السَّبِيلِ” (*sawa as-sabeel*) means the middle of the road.

“سَوَاءُ الْجَحِيمِ” (*sawa al-jaheem*): the centre of *jahanum* (hellish society) in (37:54).

“فَسَوَّيَا” (*fasawwaha*): God levelled their cities to the ground (91:14) i.e. all their dwellings were destroyed {T}.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:42	If only they had been annihilated before hand	لَوْ كُنْتُمْ بِحِمِّ الْأَرْضِ
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Surah *Al-Kahaf* says “سَوًى” (*sawa*) to mean make it level (18:96)

“سَوًى” (*siwyun*) and “السَّوَاءُ” (*as-siwaa*) also mean ‘other’.

“مَرَرْتُ بِرَجُلٍ سِوَاكَ وَسِوَاكَ” (*marartu bi-rajulin siwaaka*): was spent time with someone other than yourself {T}.

Surah *An-Najam* (53:6) uses the term “فَاسْتَوًى” (*fastawaya*) about the last messenger (*pbuh*) to refer to to describe his completely balanced personality which had all the characteristics of knowledge and vision which defined the upper most scales in the human self-development. The attributes of this personality are referred within the Quran as a model for us to follow through the study of the book. The selection for the revelation was based on a certain criterion by God and this is evident from the Quran. The messengers were then provided guidance as they lived their life through the revelation of the message. The final message has now been revealed to the mankind through the last messenger as the book has been completed.

S-Y-B

س ي ب

“سَابَ” (*saab*), “يَسِيبُ” (*yaseeb*): he walked fast {T}.

“سَابَ الْمَاءُ” (*saabal maa-u*): the water flowed everywhere.

Ibn Faris says it means to move continuously.

“سَابَ الْمَاءُ” (*saibil maa-i*): water started flowing.

“سَيَّيْتُ” (*sayyabtu*): I freed that thing to go wherever it wants.

“السَّاءِيَةُ” (*as-sa'ibah*) is derived from this root as well.

During the period before the advent of Islam, the Arabs had a practice of letting an animal (camel, or cow etc.) go free in the name of some god. These animals could feed and drink from where ever they wanted and nobody would prevent them from doing this. The Quran says that Allah has not endorsed such superstitious practices and all these are self-made customs by your fore-fathers. The Quran directed to stop these (and others) superstitious practices (5:103).

”سَاخَ الْمَاءُ“ (*saahal maa-u*): for water to flow on the ground.
 ”السَّيْحُ“ (*as-saih*): flowing water on the surface of the ground {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to keep moving continuously.

”السَّيَّاحَةُ“ (*as-siyaha*): to move along the land, tourism (9:2). Some think that ”الْمَسِيحُ“ (*al-maseeh*) has been derived from this root. Still others say that it is not an Arabic word. See also heading (M-S-H).
 ”السَّاءُ“ (*as-saa'ih*): one who travels for pleasure, tourist {T}.

The Quran has said that one of the characteristics of a Momin (believer) is that he is ”السَّائِحُونَ“ (*as-sayihoon*) as noted in (9:112). For Momin women, it has used ”سَاهَاتُ“ (*sa-ihaat*) in (66:5). Although some say that it means those who fast, but *Raghib* has written that it means those who as per God's guidance go about in the land to gain knowledge, discover and learn new things and share it with others. This meaning seems more appropriate. This points to the fact that the Quran has included this character as a hallmark of the believing men and women and asked them not to remain confined in one part of the earth. This life is meant to be explored and discovered through learning and sharing for the good of mankind at large. Putting any restrictions on the free movement of men and women is directly against this value and Allah has disapproved it.

22:46	Have they not travelled through the earth? Do they not have understanding with which they can grasp, or ears with which to hear? It is not their eyes that are blind, but the hearts in their breasts are.	أَفَلَمْ يَسِيرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ فَتَكُونَ لَهُمْ قُلُوبٌ يَعْقِلُونَ بِهَا أَوْ آذَانٌ يَسْمَعُونَ بِهَا فَإِنَّهَا لَا تَعْمَى الْأَبْصَارُ وَلَكِنْ تَعْمَى الْقُلُوبُ الَّتِي فِي الصُّدُورِ
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”السَّاحَةُ“ (*as-saahatuh*): open space, ground, open space between houses, the open space in front of a house.

”سَاحَةُ الدَّارِ“ (*saahaqud daar*): terrace space (37:177)

”السَّيْرُ“ (*as-sair*): to walk, to go, either in daytime or at night.
 ”سَرَى“ (*sara*) means only to walk at night (17:1, 15:65). See heading (S-R-Y).
 ”سَارَ الرَّجُلُ“ (*saarur rajul*): the man walked.
 ”سَيَّرَهُ“ (*sayyerah*): he made him walk, took him from one place to another.
 ”سَيْرَةٌ“ (*seerah*): way, speed, the way of walking, built, condition.

20:21	we will return it to its former condition	سَنُعِيدُهَا سِيرَتَهَا الْأُولَى
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”السَّيَّارَةُ“ (*as-sayyaarah*): the group which goes together, caravan (12:19).

The Quran repeatedly quotes historic facts as an evidence from the past:

6:11	Move through the earth and see the fate of those who thought our laws were untrue	سِيرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ ثُمَّ انظُرُوا كَيْفَ كَانَ عَاقِبَةُ الْمُكَذِّبِينَ
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If those nations exist, then study their present condition and the level of development, but if these civilisations have ceased to exist, then through archaeology study their history and signs and learn lessons in the light of the permanent values revealed in the Quran.

- “سَالَ الْمَاءُ” (*saalal maa-u*): the water flowed.
 “أَسَالَه” (*a'saalah*): someone spilled it, or let it flow.
 “مَاءٌ سَيْلٌ” (*maa-un seyl*): the water which flowed.
 “السَّيْلُ” (*as-sayl*): abundantly flowing water, flood.
 “السَّيْلَةُ” (*as-seelah*): the way or manner in which the water flows.

The Quran says:

13:17	valleys are flooded flood takes away the foam with it.	فَسَالَتْ أَوْدِيَةٌ - فَاخْتَمَلَ السَّيْلُ زَبَدًا
34:12	we made a copper spring flow for him	وَأَسْلَمْنَا لَهُ عَيْنَ الْقِطْرِ
34:16	Big and fast flood	سَيْلٌ الْعَرِمِ

Seen

سین

“سَ” (*as-seen*) is a letter, but “يَسَ” (*yaseen*) (36:1) means O’ man, or O’ leader. The dictionary “طے” (tey) says that “يَسَ” (*yaseen*) means O’ man.

Actually it is the abbreviation of the word “إِنْسَانٌ” (*insaan*), and historically the Arabs at the time used to making abbreviations in their language.

“كَفَى بِالسَّيْفِ شَاءَ” (*kafa bis saifi sha*) is an abbreviation for “كَفَا بِالسَّيْفِ شَاهِدًا” (*kafa bis saif shahida*) which means that this is a verse by some poet.

“قُلْنَا لَهَا قَفِي لَنَا قَالَتْ قَافٌ” (*qulna laha qifi lana qaalat qaf*). Here instead of saying “وَقَفْتُ” (*waqaftu*) it is only said “قَافٌ” (*qaf*).

“السَّيْنُ” (*as-seen*) means pillar or support. If some link of the ceiling becomes weak then some “سَيْنٌ” (*seen*) is put up to support it.

“سِينَاءُ” (*seena*) is a kind of stone.

“طُورُ سَيْنِينَ” (*toori seeneen*) as in (95:2), and “مِنْ طُورِ سِينَاءَ” (*min toori seena*) as in (23:20) is the mountain in Syria on which *Moosa* had gone to receive the revelation. See heading (Seen)

“السَّيْنِيْنَةُ” (*as-seeninah*) is a kind of tree.

“الْيَدِ الشُّؤْمَى” (*al-yadush ashuma*): left hand, as opposite of “الْيُمْنَى” (*al-yumna*) which means right hand.
 “الشُّؤْمُ” (*ash-shoom*) is the opposite of “يُمْنٌ” (*yumna*) i.e. ill boding.

Taj-ul-Uroos says “شُؤْمٌ” (*shoom*) means such deeds which are disliked and feared.

“قَدَّشَأْمَهُمْ” (*qad sha aamahum*): he boded ill for them.
 “رَجُلٌ مَشْءُومٌ” (*rajulun mash-uoom*): ill boded man {T}, {F}.

For the Quranic meaning of “نحوست” (*nahusat*), see heading (N-H-S).

The Quran (56:9) has used “أَصْحَابُ الْمَشْأَمَةِ” (*ashaab al-mash'amah*), or people on the right hand, against “أَصْحَابُ الْمَيْمَنَةِ” (*ashaab al-maymanah*), or the ones on the left hand (the ill-fated ones)

Syria is called “شَامٌ” (*sham*) because it is to the left of the central (Mecca) {T}.

“الشَّأْنُ” (*ash-shaan*): especially important matter, issue or condition {T}. Plural is “الشُّؤُنُ” (*ash-shu oon*).

Raghib says it is said for matters or condition of great importance {T}.

“شَأْنٌ” (*shaana*), “شَأْنُهُ” (*shanahu*): he intended it.

“شَأْنٌ” (*shaan*): important matters, because they are a thing of deliberate intent. It also means that he did something which he could do well.

“شَأْنُ الرَّأْسِ” (*shaanur raas*): the confluence of the small bones of the skull.

“الشَّأْنُ” (*ash-shaan*): a blood vessel which takes blood to the eye. It also means the path which brings tears to the eyes.

“شُؤْنُ الْخَمْرِ” (*shu-oonul khumr*): that part of liquor which permeates the body {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically mean to search, demand and intent.

Surah *Ar-Rahman* says:

55:29	whatever there is in the highs and lows of the universe is dependent on the nurturer for its development	يَسْأَلُهُ مَنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ - كُلُّ يَوْمٍ هُوَ فِي شَأْنٍ
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This is the translation of the first part of the verse. In the second part “هُوَ” (*huwa*) is taken to mean Allah which is translated as Allah is in a different form of grandeur every moment. We think it is wrong, because Allah is a permanent entity which is constantly in a similar state of grandeur, though His powers may be displayed in different ways. As such, if in the second part of the verse above “هُوَ” (*huwa*) is taken to mean “مَنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ” (*mun fis samawati fil ard*), it will be more appropriate. This way, the full verse would mean that everything in the universe is dependent on him for its development and the needs of things keep changing with time. In different situations their needs for development are different and Allah sustains them according to their changing needs (14:34). In this way, the development of things in the universe continues according to the law of evolution.

“تَشَابَهَ” (*tashabah*) means for two things to be so similar that it becomes difficult to distinguish one from the other.

“شَبَّهَ إِيَّاهُ” (*shabbahu iyyahu*): he made that thing like the other thing, made them similar, look alike.

“الشَّيْبُ” (*ash-shibhu*), “الشَّابَهُ” (*ash-shabahu*), “الشَّيْبَةُ” (*as-shibyah*): alike, similar to.

“شُبِّهَ عَلَيْهِ الْأَمْرُ” (*shubbihah alaihil amr*): the matter became doubtful or unclear (ambiguous) for him {T}.

“تَشْبِيهُ” (*tashbih*): to describe a thing by referring to a similar thing.

“مُتَشَابِهٌ” (*mushabahah*): to resemble one another {T}, {M}.

The Quran says:

2:25	Similar	مُتَشَابِهًا
2:70	We can't understand what sort of cow should it be because all cows are similar to us and this throws us into doubt (or confusion)	إِنَّ الْبَقَرَ تَشَابَهَ عَلَيْنَا
2:119	their hearts are alike (are mutually agreed)	تَشَابَهَتْ قُلُوبُهُمْ
6:100	mutually alike and dissimilar	مُتَشَابِهًا وَغَيْرَ مُتَشَابِهٍ
6:144	mutually alike and dissimilar	مُتَشَابِهًا وَغَيْرَ مُتَشَابِهٍ

The noble Quran has two types of verses which are “مَحْكَمَاتٌ” (*muhkamaat*) and “مُتَشَابِهَاتٌ” (*mutashaabihaat*), as explained in 3:6. For detailed discussion on this, see heading (H-K-M) and (Th-N-Y).

Surah *An-Nisa* says in the tale about *Isa* that the Jews neither crucified Jesus nor murder him.

4:157	the truth became doubtful for them (what had actually happened)	وَلَكِنْ شُبِّهَ لَهُمْ
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For details see my book “*Shola-e-Mastoor*” in the part about Jesus.

“شَتَّاهُ” (*shattah*), “يَشْتُتُهُ” (*yashuttuhu*), “شَتَّاهُ” (*shatta*), “شَتَّاتًا” (*shatata*): he separated or differentiated them, removed them.

“شَتَّ” (*shat*): he became different and unlike.

“أَمْرٌ شَتٌّ” (*amrun shat*): different matter {t, m}. The plural is “أَشْتَاتٌ” (*ashtaat*).

“جَاءُوا أَشْتَاتًا” (*ja'oo ashtata*): they came individually, and separately.

Surah *An-Noor* says “جَمِيعًا أَوْ أَشْتَاتًا” (*jami'a au ashtata*) in 24:61 to mean together or separately.

Surah *Al-Lail* says:

92:4	your struggle is in different directions	إِنَّ سَعْيَكُمْ لَشَتَّى
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This verse means that there is a purpose to every man's life and each has its own purpose.

There can be various aims in a man's life too, for the attainment of which he strives. The Quran says that although a man can have several purposes in life, but overall they can be classified into two categories. One is “أَعْطَى” (*aata*) as in 62:5, and the other is “بَحَلَ” (*bakhil*) as in 9:82. “أَعْطَى” (*aata*) means that a man gives from his earnings for the development of others, and “بَحَلَ” (*bakhil*) means that he keeps them only for himself. The previous case is the height of humanity and the other cause for demeaning of humanity.

Surah *Taha* says “نَبَاتٍ شَتَّى” (*nabaatin shatta*) in 20:53 to mean various types of herbs and plants.

“شَتَّى” (*shatta*) is the plural of “شَتَّيْتُ” (*shateet*) which means that which has been separated, differentiated, individualised.

“الشَّتَاءُ” (*ash-shita*): winter. The Arabs divided the year into two parts. One was “شَتَاءُ” (*shita'a*) and the other “صَيْفُ” (*saif*). Furthermore, “شَتَاءُ” (*shita'a*) was divided in two parts of. The last three months of this period were “رَبِيعُ” (*rabih*), and last period was “صَيْفُ” (*saif*) which had the last three months of “قَيْظُ” (*qaiz*). Since in winter the Arabs hardly went out of their homes to go and make a living, in these months there was dearth of fodder and grain. Therefore “الشَّتَاءُ” (*ash-shita'a*) also meant drought, and “صَاحِبُ الشَّتْوَةِ” (*saahibush shatu*) as a person whom got frustrated of winter and drought, and sought for help {T, M}.

The Quran says about the caravans of the *Quresh* tribe:

106:2	their travels in winter and summer (all year around)	رَحَلَةَ الشَّتَاءِ وَالصَّيْفِ
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“شَجَرٌ” (*shajar*) means anything that disperses after gathering together {T}.
 “شَجَرَ بَيْنَهُمْ” (*shajara bainahum*) means to quarrel among themselves because of differences.

The Quran says:

2:65	mutual disagreement	فِيَمَا شَجَرَ بَيْنَهُمْ
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“شَاجِرَ فُلَانٍ فُلَانًا” (*shajarun fulanun fulana*): so and so differed with so and so.

“الشَّجَرُ” (*ash-shajar*): tree. This is the plural while singular is “شَجَرَةٌ” (*shajarah*), probably because it has one trunk but many different branches. This is the basic meaning of “شَجَرٌ” (*shajar*).

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “تَشَاجَرَ” (*tashajar*) means for the armies to engage in hand to hand combat. Since the branches of a tree are also seemingly engaged with each other, this is why a tree is called “شَجَرٌ” (*shajar*), but the former meaning is more plausible i.e. for a tree having one trunk but many branches.

Ibn Faris says it means for something to be lofty or high and its elements to be engaged with others.

In the Quran, in the tale about *Adam*, it is said:

2:35	do not go near that tree	فَلَا تَقْرَبَا هَذِهِ الشَّجَرَةَ
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As related in the tale about *Adam*, the tale is actually a detailed account of human story. Man prior to his civilized life used to exist on a few needs and the food supply was abundant, hence there were no differences between them. Later when humans began civilized life, they got led to clash of interest between individuals and tribes, and this led to differences among them:

10:19	mankind was one group earlier but later they began to differ among themselves	وَمَا كَانَ النَّاسُ إِلَّا أُمَّةً وَاحِدَةً فَاخْتَلَفُوا
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Humanity has to reunite once again, but this unity is not possible without the guidance of revelation (2:213). This is the connotation of 2:35. That is, they were all told that their reality (beginning) was the same, therefore, they should not develop mutual differences. Later on, self-interests which teaches every individual to protect his own interests, and is a devilish intellect, led them to selfish interests and thus they became each other's enemy (2:36). As such, at this point “شَجَرٌ” (*shajar*) would mean those mutual differences among human beings which arouse because of pursuing selfish interest.

And which can be resolved only by living according to the system of the revelation (2:38), which teaches us to equally share the available sustenance.

“الشُّحُّ” (*ash-shuh*): to comprehend the right meaning of this word we have to visualize very harsh summer time when there is very little water and lot of thirsty people. In this situation people would certainly try to get ahead of each other in order to get a drink. This situation is called “تَشَاخَا الْمَاءُ” (*tashaha ha ma'a*), or “تَشَاهَا” (*tashah ha hu*) {T}.

The Quranic system is that everyone should prefer the need of others over those of themselves. So “شَحَّ نَفْسٍ” (*shuhhin nafsi*) would be opposite to this system.

Surah *Al-Hashar's* verse makes this clear when it says the following for a Momin:

59:9	A Momin's trait is that he may be in dire straits himself, but he prefers the needs of others to before his own	يُؤْتِرُونَ عَلَى أَنْفُسِهِمْ وَلَوْ كَانَ بِهِمْ خَصَاصَةٌ
59:9	remember, those he who protect themselves from <i>shuh hi nafs</i> (selfish interests), are the ones whose crops grow well	وَمَنْ يُوقَ شُحَّ نَفْسِهِ فَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُفْلِحُونَ

In other words, a Momin is he who prefers watering the fields for someone else.

“تَشَاخَ الْقَوْمُ” (*tashah halqum*): people tried to get ahead of each other, lest the thing remains out of their reach.

“تَشَاخَا عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*tashah ha aslal amr*): they both quarrelled in the matter, and none was ready to let the matter go {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to withhold something.

With this meaning “تَشَاخَ الْقَوْمُ” (*tashah hul quum*) would not only mean that nations tried to get ahead of one another, but also that in order to get ahead, they tried to stop others from doing so. This makes the meaning of “شُحَّ” (*shuh*) clear. It is the psychological attitude to get ahead and grab something for you, and to stop others from getting to it.

According to this connotation, “الشُّحُّ” (*ash-shuh*) would mean the worst type of selfishness which has both greed and miserliness in it. Some say that miserliness is confined only to wealth but “شُحَّ” (*shuh*) is used for miserliness or confining all sorts of things for self-including wealth {T}. Not only for reserving for self but also for stopping them from reaching anyone else.

Raghib says it is “شُحَّ” (*shuh*) when this habit is found habitually in a person.

“إِبِلٌ شَحَاءُ” (*iblu shaha-ih*): a camel which gives very little milk.

“زَنْدٌ شَحَاحٌ” (*zandun shuhah*): fire stones which do not spark fire.

“مَاءٌ شَحَاحٌ” (*ma-un sha-ha*): very little water {M}.

Surah *Al-Azaab* says “أَشِيْهَةً” (*ashihah*) in 13:19. Singular is “شَحِيْحٌ” (*shahih*) which means to be miser and greedy.

“الشَّحْمُ” (*ash-shahm*): fat. Plural is “شُحُوْمٌ” (*shuhoom*).

“الشَّحْمَةُ” (*ash-shahmah*): piece of fat.

“الشَّحْمُ” (*ash-shahm*): a camel's hump {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

6:147	fat (of cows and goats) was made forbidden for them	حَرَّمْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ شُحُوْمَهُمَا
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”شَخَصَ“ (*shakhs*): everything seen from afar. With reference to height it is said ”شَخَصَ الْجُرْحُ“ (*shaksal jurh*): the wound became high i.e. worsened, or swelled.

”شَخَصَ شُحُوصًا“ (*shakhas shakhusa*): he rose.

”شَخَصَ السَّهْمُ“ (*shakhasas sahm*): the arrow went above the target {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris says there is a sense of height in its basic meaning.

”شَخَصَ بَصَرَهُ“ (*shakhasa basarah*): he kept his eyes open without blinking, or when someone’s eyes remain wide open due to terror {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

14:42	the eyes will be opened wide at the time of that great revolution	تَشْخَصُ فِيهِ الْأَبْصَارُ
21:97	the deniers of this system will have their eyes wide opened	فَإِذَا هِيَ شَاخِصَةٌ أَبْصَارُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا

”شَحَنَ السَّفِينَةَ“ (*shahamnas safeenata*) or ”يَشْحُنُهَا“ (*yash-hanuha*): loaded the boat with whatever goods were to be loaded {T, R}.

The Quran says:

26:119	Laden boat	الْفُلُكِ الْمَشْحُونِ
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”الشَّحْنَةُ“ (*ash-shihnah*): the goods that are loaded on a boat.

”الشَّحْنَةُ“ (*ash-shihna*): the fodder for animals which is collected and is enough for the animals for a day and a night.

”شَحَنَ“ (*shahan*), ”شَحْنًا“ (*shahna*): to reply to someone harshly, to scold, and also to distance.

”الشَّحْنَةُ“ (*ash-shihnah*): the administrator for some area appointed by the king.

”أَمُشَاحِنٌ“ (*al-mushaahin*): one who is secretly opposed {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means both, to fill and to distance, but there seems to be no link between them.

”الشَّدَّةُ“ (*al-shiddah*): hardness.

”شَدَّ“ (*shud*): he strengthened and solidified it.

”شَيْءٌ شَدِيدٌ مُشْتَدٌّ“ (*shai-un shadeedun mushtad*): very strong thing.

”الشَّدَّ“ (*ash-shud*): to tie someone up strongly.

”الشَّدَّةُ“ (*ash-shiddah*): bravery and solidarity of heart.

”إِنَّهُ لِحَبِّ الْخَيْرِ لَشَدِيدٌ“ (*inna lihbi alheer ash-shadeed*): brave, strong, miser (100:7)

”الْأَشَدُّ“ (*al-ashuddu*): maturity.

”وَأَشَدُّ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ“ (*wushdud ala qulubhim*): seal their hearts (10:88) {T, M}.

It means maturity and guidance as in 40:67, 6:153 and 17:44.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:6	oversee the wealth of orphans till they reach “age of <i>nikah</i> ”	وَابْتَالُوا أَيْتَامَهُمْ حَتَّىٰ إِذَا بُلُّغُوا النَّكَاحَ
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At other places, such as in 17:34 and 6:135 it has been said to watch over their assets till they reach maturity. This clearly shows that the age for wedding is when one grows up, not old age. This is what has

been said about the orphans whose wall was about to fall down and which *Moosa's* companion had repaired without any charge.

In 22:5 it has been used for the youth of ordinary folk. In 28:14, the same has been said about *Moosa*.

In surah *Yusuf* the word “شِدَادٌ” (*shidaadun*) has been used to mean harsh years (12:48). It is the plural of “شَدِيدٌ” (*shaded*). Its plural is also “أَشْدَاءُ” (*ashidda'a*).

Surah *Al-Fatah* describes a Momin as:

48:29	They are very hard against the opponents	أَشْدَاءُ عَلَى الْكُفَّارِ
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“أَشْدُّ” (*ashaddu*): very hard and strong (2:74).

“إِشْتَدَّ” (*ishtaddu*): to attack fiercely or to walk fast (14:18).

Sh-R-B

ش ر ب

“شَرِبَ” (*shariba*), “يَشْرَبُ” (*yashrab*): to drink, to be satiated.

“الشَّرَابُ” (*ash-sharaab*): anything which is swallowed and not chewed (2:259).

“المَشْرَبُ” (*al-mashrab*): water, to drink water, place to drink water, time or place of drinking, the manner in which the water is drunk {T, M}.

“طَعَامٌ ذُو مَشْرَبٍ” (*tu-aam un zu mashrabah*): food which after eating one gets very thirsty {Aqrah-ul-muwarid}.

The Quran says “مَشْرَبُهُمُ” (*mashrabahum*) in 2:60 to mean a place to drink or water itself.

“شَرِبَ” (*shirb*) as in 26:155 means the portion to drink water or turn to drink, or the time to drink.

“شُرِبَ” (*shuurb*) as in 56:55 means to drink.

“شَارِبٌ” (*shaarib*) as in 47:15 means one who drinks water. The plural is “شَارِبُونَ” (*shaariboon*) or “شَارِبِينَ” (*shaaribeen*).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says “يَطْعَمُهُ” (*yat-umhu*) after “شَرِبَ” (*sharib*) in 2:249. Here “شَرِبَ” (*shariba*) means to drink to the fill and “طَعِمَ” (*ta-im*) means to taste the water:

The tale of *Bani Israel* relates:

2:93	the calf lay in their hearts	وَأَشْرَبُوا فِي قُلُوبِهِمُ الْعِجْلَ
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But it means figuratively that the calf's sanctity had permeated their hearts, or that its love found its way to their hearts.

Sh-R-H

ش ر ح

“شَرَحَ” (*sharh*): to open, or make clear {T, M}.

Raghib says it means to spread the flesh. It also means to widen and expand, as well as comprehension.

“شَرَحَ الْبَابَ” (*sharahal baab*): opened the door.

“شَرَحَ الْكَلَامَ” (*sharahal kal*): comprehended a matter {M}.

The Quran says that anybody whom the Quran wants to guide:

6:126	Widens his chest for Islam (makes it more accommodating)	يَشْرَحُ صَدْرَهُ لِلْإِسْلَامِ
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This word includes the connotations of comprehension, the ability to accept the right thing, and the courage to adopt the right path. It also means conversely. About those on the wrong path is said:

6:126	It constricts his chest, narrows it	يَجْعَلْ صَدْرَهُ ضَيِّقًا حَرَجًا
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The truth is that “شَرَحَ صَدْرًا” (*sharah sadr*) is a very big specialty for whoever gets it, or to comprehend something without being biased on merits, to appreciate the truth wherever it is found, and to accept it. In other words, accept the truth despite all opposition and to propagate it in as much detail and clarity. To be courteous to everyone, be expansive towards enemies, and not be narrow minded anywhere. All these are included in “شَرَحَ صَدْرًا” (*sharah sadr*). That is why the messengers have always prayed to God to give them this “شَرَحَ صَدْرًا” (*sharah sadr*) as in 20:25, and the Messenger (*pbuh*) has been told as much that it is because of “شَرَحَ صَدْرًا” (*sharah sadr*) that his difficult mission became so easy and the burden which was breaking his back was made light (94:1-2). Otherwise the opponents were acting in a way as to make one unable to breathe (15:97).

Therefore, as per the Quran, for matters to become easy “شَرَحَ صَدْرًا” (*sharah sadr*) is necessary (94:1, 20:25-29). It must be every Muslim’s trait (6:126). Anyone who is narrow minded or lacks in courage, has not his chest widened to accept real Islam. In 39:22, this has been likened to “شَرَحَ بِهِ صَدْرًا” (*sharaha behi sadra*) which means to accept something gracefully, or to open one’s heart for it (16:106).

Sh-R-D ش ر د

“شَرَدَ الْبَعِيرُ” (*sharadal ba-ir*): the camel ran way after stampeding.
“التَّشْرِيدُ” (*at-tashreed*): to scold, to oust, to disperse, to make someone balk and run away.

Raghib says that “شَرَدْتُ بِهِ” (*sharadat behi*) means that I acted in such a way that nobody will ever follow it. They will stay away from such acts and balk at doing so.

The Quran says:

8:57	give them such a taste (teach them such a lesson) that those who are following with the same designs run away at seeing their condition (become frustrated).	فَشَرَدُوا مِنْ خَلْفِهِمْ
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Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to balk and to be distanced.

Sh-R-Dh-M ش ر ذ م

“شِرْذِمَةٌ” (*shir zimah*): a small group, a group that is breakaway.
“شِرَاذِمٌ” (*si-aabun sharazim*): rags {T, R}.

The Quran says:

26:54	an insignificant group	شِرْذِمَةٌ قَلِيلُونَ
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Ibn Faris says that the “ذ” (*dhal*) is additional in this word, which is actually derived from “شَرَمْتُ الشَّيْءَ” (*sharamtush shaiyi*), which means to tear something to bits. A small group is called “شِرْذِمَةٌ” (*shirzimah*) because it breaks away from a bigger party.

Sh-R-R ش ر ر

“شَرٌّ” (*sharr*) is the opposite of “خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) i.e. Goodness (99:8).

Lissan-ul-Arab says that “شَرٌّ” (*sharr*) means evil or badness i.e. “سُوءٌ” (*suu*).
The author of *Misbaah* says that it means oppression and chaos.

“الشَّرَارُ” (*ash-sharaar*), “الشَّرَرُ” (*ash sharer*): the sparks that fly from a fire. Singular is “شَرَارَةٌ” (*sharaarah*) and “شَرَرَةٌ” (*shararah*) as in 77:32.

“شَرَّ الْمَاءِ مِنَ الْقَرِيَّةِ” (*sharrul ma-un minal qaryah*): water continued to drip from the water bag (of leather). “الشَّرُّ” (*ash-sharru*) means intensity, happiness, anger, rage, greed and morally decrepit. It also means everything that is not according to one’s personality, or that which obstructs the attainment of his needs {M}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to scatter, to fly away hither and thither and to disburse.

Raghib says that “خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) and “شَرٌّ” (*sharr*) are ambivalent words. While a thing may be *khair* or good for someone, it could be *sharr* or bad for someone else {R}.

Since the word is the opposite of *khair*, the heading (Kh-Y-R) should also be consulted.

Ibn Faris says this word means for the spending of human capability and strength to be so spent, wasted, scattered away or disperse so as not to produce any positive result.

Conversely *khair* would mean for human forces to produce good or constructive results. When water flows within the boundaries of a river’s banks, its result is only good, but when it overflows the banks as flood, it produces negative results. When breeze blows slowly, it is cause for pleasure, but when it turns into a storm, it can only wreak havoc. When forces gets scattered or frittered away and become unbridled, they cause *sharr*. This very thing applies to human personality. If ones strengths are diffused, ones capabilities cannot develop. If they are concentrated, then they solidify.

Surah *Al-Falaq* says:

113:2	be safe from whatever that has been created	مِنْ شَرِّ مَا خَلَقَ
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This makes it clear that *sharr* is not something which has been created as such i.e, bad, as it was believed in the old days. Nothing in the universe is good or bad by itself. Everything has an evil aspect and a good aspect. One should try to avoid its evil element and adopt the good element. If water stays under the boat then it is good, but if it comes into the boat then it is not good. To utilize everything under the guidance of God’s revelation is *khair*, and to use it for human destruction is *sharr*. As far as our social evils are concerned, they are the product of our wrong social system. If a society is established under the guidance of the Quran then all the social ills will disappear. This is the same situation with individualistic pain. As human knowledge progresses, the pains are lessened.

Then there are the emotional problems which trouble us. If man is brought up in the right way, he can overcome those problems as well. When a man’s point of view is changed his whole perspective is changed. That is why “*Iblees*” has been told:

15:22	truly, you will have no power over my missionaries	إِنَّ عِبَادِي لَكِنِّي عَلَيْهِمْ مُّطَّلِعٌ
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Khair and *sharr* have appeared quite many times in Quran which reveal the truths mentioned above. Not that the Quran has not argued about good and evil in a philosophical manner, because its subject matter is not philosophy. Its purpose is to provide guidance so that *sharr* may not remain i.e. strengths do not disperse and do not produce destructive results, but consolidate in an organized way and produce constructive results. As mentioned earlier, it is the way we use things which makes them good or bad. As far as the permanent values which have been given to man through the revelation are concerned, they are inherently *khair* or good, such as justice, benevolence etc. They are opposite to bad or *sharr*. Likewise the things which have been classified by the Quran as forbidden, produce *sharr* or evil.

“الشَّرْطُ” (*ash-shart*): mark or sign that is fixed by the people. Plural is “أَشْرَاطُ” (*ash-raat*).

“الشَّرْطَةُ” (*ash-shurtah*): the first part of anything, or the front rank of the army which is ever ready to lay down lives. It also means the governor’s brigade and body guards, because they wear signs which distinguish them {*T, R, M*}. The singular is “شُرْطِي” (*shurti*).

The Quran says about the “السَّاعَةُ” (*sa-a*) or the imminent revolution, after that the decisive time, when the opponents were so defeated that they could not recover, will come.

“الشَّرِيعَةُ” (*ash-shareeya*): the spot where people and animals come to drink, but the water must be coming from a continuous spring which never ceases and is open on the surface. Ergo no effort is needed to get to the water. If it is accumulated rain water, then it is not “شَرِيعَةٌ” (*shari’ah*) but “كَرْعٌ” (*kara’a*).

“أَشَارُغٌ” (*ash-shaareh*): thorough fare:

“الشَّرْعُ” (*ash-shara’a*): straight path which is distinct and open.

Ibn-ul-Airaabi says that “شَرَعَ” (*shara*) means “ظَهَرَ” (*zahar*), i.e. was made evident, and disclosed.

“شُرِغَتِ الرِّمَاحُ” (*shuri-atir rimaah*): spears were straightened.

“أَشْرَعَ الشَّيْءُ” (*ashra-ash shaiyi*): he granted it loftiness.

“الشَّرَاغُ” (*ash-shira’a*): a boat’s sail.

“الشَّرِيعَةُ” (*ash-shari’ah*): thresh hold.

“الشَّرِيعَةُ” (*ash-shari’ah*), “الشَّرْعَةُ” (*ash-shir’ah*): straight and distinct path {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it means to open something lengthwise i.e. to open it in such a way that the whole thing can be viewed.

Surah *Ash-Shura* says:

34:13	Allah has highlighted this way of life (<i>Deen</i>) for you	شَرَعَ لَكُمْ مِنَ الدِّينِ
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Surah *Al-Jaasiah* says:

45:18	then we put you on an open and distinct path in the matter of <i>Deen</i>	ثُمَّ جَعَلْنَاكَ عَلَىٰ شَرِيعَةٍ مِّنَ الْأَمْرِ
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These verses talk about *Deen* or the path fixed by God.

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says that we have revealed this book to you with truth, which is going to prove true the truths that were revealed in prior celestial books. It is the safe keeper of those truths, so in matters that they differ decide according to Allah’s laws. When the truth has come to you then do not just follow whims and fancies. After that it is said:

5:48	and for each one of you we had designated a path and manner	لِكُلٍّ جَعَلْنَا مِنكُمْ شِرْعَةً وَ مِنْهَا حَاجًّا
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Here *Deen* does not mean those unchanging rules which have been the same from *Nooh* to our messenger *Muhammed (pbuh)* (42:13). Here *Deen* means those sub laws or rules which were given to earlier messengers temporarily according to their time, and which have been kept changing with the times.

The Quran says that the Jews and the Christians object saying that why does some of Quran’s orders are opposed to their *Shariat*, they should realize that there are some principles of *Deen* and some sub-rules. The principles do not change but the sub rules do so according to the needs of the times. Therefore, if some of these are different from that of previous nations then it cannot be concluded that the Quran is not come from God.

This meaning is confirmed by that verse of surah *Al-Hajj* which says:

22:67	We had imposed for every nation (the practical ways of implementing the deen) which they followed	لِكُلِّ أُمَّةٍ جَعَلْنَا مَنَسَكًا هُمْ نَاسِكُوهُ فَلَا يُنَازِعَنَّكَ فِي الْأَمْرِ
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There can be difference in these, but not the *Deen* itself. Therefore let them not raise an issue with you as far as the real *Deen* is concerned.

22:67 could also mean that we do not coerce anybody to follow this *Deen*, or way of life. Everyone has the right to follow the way he wants. Our job is to introduce them to this way, but it is on the humans themselves to whether follow this way or some other. This meaning is confirmed by the next verse which says:

5:48	If Allah wanted, He could have made you all follow the same way of life.	وَلَوْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ جَعَلَكُمْ أُمَّةً وَاحِدَةً
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But this would have usurped your free will, and this would be against God's wishes.

We treat *Deen* and *shariat* separately or to mean different things. *Shariat* is taken to mean those sub laws which are to be followed by the followers of Islam. The Islamic system is based on principles outlined of none other than Allah. These principles and some orders given in the Quran will never be changed, but staying within their parameters, and make sub laws in their accordance, is a requirement every nation can meet. The Quranic principles will remain unchanged but these sub laws will keep changing with time. If these sub laws can be called *shariat*, then *shariat* will keep changing as per the times, but the Quranic principles will remain constant.

The characteristics of the *shariah*, i.e. the sub rules prepared by mutual consultation by the nation within the parameters of the broader and unchanging Quranic principles, should be clear, distinct and notable. It must also be a path that is the same for everybody, such as water from which everyone can drink. Which is reachable by everyone, which is continuous and should not be like accumulated rain water which depletes after a time. As such, *shariat* must not be stagnant but should be changing continuously, along with the changing requirements of time. If it is stagnant, then like standing water, it too will develop a bad smell, and will no longer be life giving.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* has used "جِيئَانُهُمْ شُرَّعًا" (*heetanuhum shurra'a*) in 7:162

"شُرَّعًا" (*sharra'a*) is the plural of "شَارِعٌ" (*shaari*) and means a fish that raise its head high and come to the surface of the water {M}.

Ibn Faris says that it means a fish which keep its heads low. He writes that "تَشْرَبُ" (*tashrab*) means to drink water, but this could be a printing error and the right word is could be "تَسْرَبُ" (*tasrab*). But the point at which this has been used in the Quran, shows that the earlier meaning is more appropriate.

Bani Israel used Saturday as a holiday and did not work on that day. Therefore their fishermen did not catch fish on that day. When fish or other animals from continuous experience find no danger at a certain time, they openly come within human presence without fear. But the greedy among *Bani Israel* used to take advantage of this trait of the fish and used to catch it, even on the day of *Sabbath*. See details under heading (S-B-T).

“الشَّرْقُ” (*as-sharq*): an opening.

“شَرَقَ الشَّاةَ” (*sharaqash shah*): split the ear of the goat.

“التَّشْرِيقُ” (*at-tashreeq*): to cut the flesh or tear it apart.

“أَيَّامُ التَّشْرِيقِ” (*ayyaamush shareeq*): three days of *Eid-ul-Azha* (when animals are slaughtered as a sacrifice to Allah) {T}.

Ibn Faris says that this word basically means to enlighten and to open.

“شَرَقَتِ الشَّمْسُ” (*sharaqatis shams*): the sun rose.

“أَشْرَقَتِ الشَّمْسُ” (*ashraqatis shams*): the sun illuminated.

“أَيَّامُ التَّشْرِيقِ” (*ayaamuttashreeq*): days when meat is sundried.

“الشَّرْقُ” (*ash-sharq*) also means the sun, when it has risen or has been illuminated.

“طَلَعَتِ الشَّرْقُ” (*tala'tish ashraq*) means the sun came out, “غَرَبَتِ الشَّرْقُ” (*gharabitish sharq*) is never used.

“الشَّرْقُ” (*ash-sharq*): for the sun to come up, the place from where the sun rises, that is, the east.

“الشَّارِقُ” (*ash-shaariq*): the sun, at the time when it is rising {T, M}.

“شَرَقَ النَّخْلُ” (*sharagan nakhlu*) and “أَشْرَقَ” (*ashraq*): date palms became tall or white flowers bloomed on them.

“شَرَقَ الدَّمُ فِي عَيْنِهِ” (*shariqad damu fi ainihi*): his eye became red {T, M}.

“الْمَشْرِقَانِ” (*al-mashriqaan*): two points at which the sun rises in summer and the winter {T, M}.

The Quran has used “مَشْرِقٌ” (*maghrib*) as against “مَغْرِبٌ” (*mashriq*) in 2:115. Surah *Saad* has used “بِالْعَشِيِّ” (*bil ashiyyi*) against “الْإِشْرَاقِ” (*al-ishraq*) in 38:18.

Surah *Ar-Rahman* says:

55:17	Sustainer of the extreme points of summer and winter from which the sun rises and sets	رَبُّ الْمَشْرِقَيْنِ وَرَبُّ الْمَغْرِبَيْنِ
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The whole world is meant by it. Likewise “مَشْرِقٌ” (*mashariq*) and “مَغْرِبٌ” (*magharib*) has also been used for the east and west in 70:40 and only “مَشَارِقُ” (*mashaariq*) has also been used in 37:5.

Surah *Al-Airaaq* says that *Bani Israel* was made the owners of the lush lands in the “مَشْرِقٌ” (*mashariq*) as well as in “مَغْرِبٌ” (*magharib*) in 7:137. This means all parts of the blessed land which were situated in the east and west, or the entire area, because the Quran has further said:

2:115	the entire universe	وَلِلَّهِ الْمَشْرِقُ وَالْمَغْرِبُ
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Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:35	He is above the relationships of the <i>mashriq</i> or <i>magharib</i> (the whole universe).	لَا شَرْقِيَّةَ وَلَا غَرْبِيَّةَ
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His light illuminates the entire universe. Just as God is the God of all humanity, so are His laws light (enlightenment) for all humans, and his system of sustenance is for all humans.

39:69	This is the light which at long last will illuminate the whole world	وَأَشْرَقَتِ الْأَرْضُ بِنُورِ رَبِّهَا
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“إِشْرَاقٌ” (*ishraq*) has been used by the Quran for the day to proceed in 38:18, while 15:72 has used “مَشْرِقِينَ” (*mushriqeen*). This means that they faced punishment when there was sunlight, or at the time of sunrise.

“الشِّرْكُ” (*as-shirk*) basically means to stick to, to hang on to, become inter mingled.

“شَارَكْتُ فُلَانًا” (*shaaraktu fulanan*): became companion or friend.

“اِسْتَرَكَّ الْأَمْرُ” (*ishtarkal amr*): the matter got confused or intermingled.

“مُشَارَكَةٌ” (*musharakah*): to be partners in something.

“فُلَانٌ شَرِيكُ فُلَانٍ” (*fulanun sharikun fulanun*): he is his partner or companion. It also means to marry a girl and be part of her family. The plural is “شُرَكَاءُ” (*shuraka'a*).

“اَشْرَكَ” (*ash-sharaku*): the net of a hunter, the small pathways that emerge from a bigger path “اُمُّ الطَّرِيقِ” (*ummut tareeq*), and end after going some way. Singular is “شَرَكَةٌ” (*sharakah*).

“شِرْكٌ” (*shirk*) is a particular term of the Quran. It means to consider non godly things as Allah's contemporary, or to consider that others also have the same powers as Allah. It can be understood as considering man-made laws to be equal to that of Allah's laws, or to accept the right of others where Allah's right should be acknowledged. The Quran teaches that everything in this universe has been subjugated to man and all men are equal. No one has the right to make anyone obey him. As such, there is no power higher than man on this earth, i.e. humans are all equal and everything else in the universe is subservient to them. Only one being, that is, Allah is above humans. Hence accepting anyone other than Allah to be superior to him is an insult to mankind.

This is what “شِرْكٌ” (*shirk*) is. It makes no difference to Allah's divinity. Man himself falls from the high pedestal of humanness by indulging in “شِرْكٌ” (*shirk*). This is why Quran says that “شِرْكٌ” (*shirk*) is the greatest crime or sin.

“مُشْرِكِينَ” (*mushrikeen*) are those who fall from man's stature, and consider others then Allah to be superior to them. “تَوْحِيدٌ” (*tauheed*) or oneness means the obedience of one Allah's laws (which He has given through the revelation and which are preserved in the Quran) and the conquering of the entire universe. Even a little digression in this is considered “شِرْكٌ” (*shirk*).

“اَشْرَكَ” (*ashrak*): he was guilty of *shirk*, or of sharing Allah's place with others.

“مُشْرِكٌ” (*mushrik*): one who commits *shirk*. The plurals are “مُشْرِكُونَ” (*mushrikoon*) and “مُشْرِكِينَ” (*mushrikeen*).

At the time Quran was being revealed, there was one group of people which was claiming to be obedient to God's revelation. These people were called the ones with the book. They are the Jews and Christians. The other group was not obedient to any celestial law. They were followers of self-made customs and traditions. According to their own concept, they were obedient to Allah but were as well obedient to other Gods. These people were called *mushrikeen*, or those who think Allah's divinity was also shared by other forces. Since both of these groups were deniers of the Quran, they were called *kafireen*, or the deniers. These terms do differentiate between them but the fact is that even those with the book were not really obeying Allah's laws, but were actually following man made laws. They followed the religion given to them by their religious scholars. The laws of Allah in their real shape were no longer with them at all, and whatever they had was also a formality. Their deeds or acts were dependent on the writ of the scholars. As such, in deed they too were *mushrikeen*, as the Quran calls them in 2:135:

Deen of oneness is the right path, and the different sects are those small pathways which mislead man to other directions and meet a dead end after going some way. That is why the Quran has called sectarianism as *shirk* in 30:31-32, because in sects the last authorities are human beings and not Allah. In *Deen*, any argument or the last word belongs to Allah's laws only.

As such *shirk* not only means to worship idols and statues, it is also means to give man-made laws the status of Allah's law (and this is big *shirk*). In this way they divide God's *Deen* into different sects. The Quran says that those who do this call themselves *Momin*, but in fact are *mushrik*.

12:106	most of them believe in Allah but in such a way as to be <i>mushriks</i>	وَمَا يُؤْمِنُ أَكْثَرُهُمْ بِاللَّهِ إِلَّا وَهُمْ مُشْرِكُونَ
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Just as Quran discusses one-ness or unity of Allah all through the book, it also discusses *shirk* and its elements. The Quran's basic teaching is to obliterate *shirk* and establish oneness. "لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ" (*la ilaha illal lah*) is aimed towards this meaning. That is, denial or refusal to obey any law except Allah's law and to accept Allah's law whole-heartedly and practically. Muslims and *mushriks* are opposites of one another (3:63), and the believers on non-godly forces and the acceptors of devilish authority are "مُشْرِكِينَ" (*mushrikeen*) (16:99-100).

A point should be clarified here. There will be several places in the Quran where waging war against the *mushrikeen* is advocated. This does not mean that *Muslims* go to war against the world's *mushrikeen* in any case. At these places the *mushrikeen* at the time of revelation of the Quran are meant, that had created conditions that led to battles. Thus war will be waged only against those who create that sort of conditions. In other words, there will be no war against *mushrikeen* only because they are *mushrikeen*. War will be fought only with those who create war-like conditions. For this there are detailed orders in the Quran.

But the position of the *mushrikeen* and the relationship with them which the Quran has determined will remain the same always.

Whatever has come above means that:

- To think that anyone shares the forces and authority reserved for Allah alone, is *shirk*.
- To think that one is subservient or obedient to any force or human being except Allah, or is bowed before is *shirk*.
- To accept the supremacy of anyone or anything except the Quran is *shirk*, and to follow any law excepting this law is *shirk*.
- *Deen* formulates unity within the nation of believers of Allah. To be divided into sects is *shirk*.
- One God, one code of life given by Him, its followers is one nation, one system for this nation. This is what oneness is. Anything besides it is *shirk*.

Sh-R-Y

ش ر ی

"شَرَى" (*shara*) means to buy as well as to sell. The word "بَاعَ" (*bai*) also has similar meanings. When barter system was the mode of trading, goods were exchanged in return for goods and not currency, because currency had not yet been invented. Thus buying and selling used to take place simultaneously since object were exchanged instead of being paid for with money. As such, this word meant both, buying and selling {T, R, M}.

"شَرَى" (*shara*) actually means to give up possession of a thing and take another thing in one's possession instead.

"اِشْتَرَاءَ" (*ishtira'a*): giving up one way and adopting another {T}.

Raghib says "شَرَى" (*shara*) is for selling and "اِشْتَرَى" (*ishtaras*) is mostly used for buying.

The Quran says "يَشْرِي نَفْسَهُ" (*yashri nafsehi*) in 2:208 to mean sell oneself. It says in 12:20 "وَشَرَوْهُ بِثَمَنٍ" (*washrauhu besamanin bakhs*). Here as well it means to sell away, but "اِنَّ اللَّهَ اشْتَرَى" (*innallahash tara*) in 9:11 means to buy.

Quran says in 2:16 "اُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ اشْتَرَوُا الضَّلَالَةَ بِالْهَدْيِ" (*oolaiikal lazeenaash tara wuz zaalatah bil huda*). Here it means to give up the right guidance and to be misled.

"شَرَيَانٌ" (*sharyaan*), "شَرَايِينُ" (*shiryaan*) is a kind of tree whose wood is used to make bows. It also means that vein of the human body which keeps throbbing. The plural is "شَرَايِينُ" (*sharayeen*).

"شَرَى" (*shara*) also means to spread {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris writes that the connotations to be agitated and to rise are also found in this word.

"شَرَى الْبَعِيرُ فِي سَبْعِهِ" (*sharial ba-ir fi saa irehi*) is used for a fast walking camel {F}.

The Quran says:

9:111	Verily, Allah has bought (traded) their lives and wealth in return for the jannat (heaven)	إِنَّ اللَّهَ اشْتَرَىٰ مِنْ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَنْفُسَهُمْ وَأَمْوَالَهُمْ بِأَنَّ لَهُمُ الْجَنَّةَ
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This is not just a concept but the very basis of an Islamic republic and state. In it, the system of the state which is formulated for establishing the laws of Allah makes a pact with the individuals. This pact trades the lives and wealth of the citizens in exchange for a heavenly society on earth. It is obvious that if a nation's life on this earth becomes heavenly, it also gets heaven after death. Details can be found in my book *Nizaam-e-Raboobiyat*.

Sh-Te-A ش ط أ

“الشَّطْءُ” (*ash-shat'u*): date or the crops needles (vermiculites), new saplings.

“الشَّطْءُ مِنَ الشَّجَرِ” (*ash-shat uminal shajar*): branches that sprout near the root of the tree.

“شَطَا الْوَادِي وَ النَّهْرِ” (*shat ul-waadi wan nahar*): the edge of the valley or bank of a river, or beach {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

48:29	like the crop which sprouts needles or plant hairs	كَزْرَعٍ أَخْرَجَ شَطْأَهُ
28:30	from the edge of this blessed valley	مِنْ شَاطِئِ الْوَادِ الْأَيْمَنِ

Sh-Te-R ش ط ر

“الشَّطْرُ” (*ash-shatr*): a part which is separated from the whole. Later it began to be used to mean one side of anything, no matter if it is not separated from it.

It also means ends, towards, environs, direction etc. It also means to be distanced.

“الشَّطِيرُ” (*as-shateer*) means foreigner, stranger, also far, distant,

“مَنْزِلٌ شَطِيرٌ” (*manzilun shateer*): a distant destination.

“الشَّاطِرُ” (*ash-shaatir*): a fast horse used for taking mail {T}.

“شَطَرٌ” (*shatara*): direction

“شَطْرَهُ” (*shatrah*): he intened to go towards him.

“الشَّطْرُ” (*ash-shatr*): the half of something {M}.

The Quran has used this word to mean direction and manner:

2:114	towards <i>masjid-ul-haraam</i>	شَطْرَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ
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Ibn Faris says “شَطْرٌ” (*shatr*) is said when the connotation of distance is also included.

Sh-Te-Te ش ط ت

“شَطٌّ” (*shat*), “يَشُطُّ” (*yashut*), “شَطًّا” (*shatta*): to be distanced, to surpass the limit, to be unjust.

“أَشَطُّ” (*ashatt*) is also used for the latter meaning {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

38:22	decide justly between us and do not be unjust	فَاخْكُمْ بَيْنَنَا بِالْحَقِّ وَلَا تُشْطِطْ
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That is, do not take us away from the truth, or be distanced from it.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:14	we will say something that is far away and distanced from the truth.	لَقَدْ قُلْنَا إِذَا شَطَطًا
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“شَطَطًا” (*wala tushtit*) in 38:22 means do not lean to any (one) side.

Sh-Te-N ش ط ن

“شَطَنَ” (*shatan*) means strong, long rope.

“بئر شَطُونٍ” (*beirun shatun*): a deep well.

“شَطِينٌ” (*shateen*) or “شَاطِنٌ” (*shaatin*): anything that is very far.

Ar-Rumani says “شَطَّ” (*shatt*), “شَطَنَ” (*shatan*) and “بَعَدَ” (*ba'ad*) means to be distanced, and are of the same meaning {*Al-fazul Mutaradifa*}.

Ibn Faris too says it means to be distanced.

“شَطَنَ” (*shatan*) means that he went too far.

“شَطَنَ صَاحِبَهُ” (*shatana sahibahu*): he opposed his companion, and intended to oppose him, to be rebellious {*T*}.

The word “شَيْطَانٌ” (*shaitaan*) has been derived from it, which will mean:

- to be far away or distance from Allah's blessings, removed or deprived of life's happiness.
- one who gives up the right path and adopts the wrong way by being rebellious.
- an ugly snake.

“رُؤُوسُ الشَّيَاطِينِ” (*ru-oosush-shverseen*): a head snake (cobra) {*T*}.

Ibn Faris too says these are its basic meanings.

Some think that *shaitaan* has been derived from “شَاطَ” (*shaat*) or “يَشِيْطُ” (*yasheet*).

“شَيِطَ” (*shait*) means to be incinerated, to be killed.

“شَاطَ الشَّيْءُ” (*shata-shaiyi*): the thing burned up.

“شَاطَ السَّمْنُ وَ الزَّيْتُ” (*shaatas saman waz zait*): the oil heated up so much that it almost caught fire.

“شَيْطَانٌ” (*shaitaan*) would hence mean fiery, rebellious, and producing negative results.

In the Hebrew language, *shaitaan* means one who obstructs.

The Quran says:

19:44	<i>shaitaan</i> is rebellious against Allah's orders	إِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ كَانَ لِلرَّحْمَنِ عَصِيًّا
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Surah *Al-Qasas* says that when *moosa* hit the *qubti* a punch in anger which killed him, he said:

28:15	This is a <i>shitaani</i> deed	هَذَا مِنْ عَمَلِ الشَّيْطَانِ
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Thus it is obvious that anything done when overwhelmed by emotions (in this case anger) is attributed to *shaitanat* (devilishness), as in 12:5. The leaders of the people rebellious to Allah's orders were also termed as “شَيَاطِينُ” (*shayateen*):

2:14	when they go to their party leaders	وَإِذَا خَلَوْا إِلَى شَيَاطِينِهِمْ
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The wild and rebellious tribes which *Suleman* had subjugated and made to work for him are also called *shayateen* (38:37, 21:82). To mean snake, this word has been used in the tale about *Ayyub* (38:41). In the *Gharib-ul-Quran* by *Mirza Abul Fazal*, it has been mentioned with reference to *Qamoos*, that “شَيْطَانٌ” (*shaitaan*) also means the intensity of thirst.

In the tale about *Ayyub* it is said:

38:41	the snake to have touched (or the overwhelming of thirst)	إِنِّي مَسْنِي الشَّيْطَانُ
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Also 8:11 says “رَجَزَ الشَّيْطَانُ” (*rijzas shaitaan*) where the meaning could be the weakness and trouble born out of thirst.

The Quran says:

37:65	whatever sprouts from it is like a snake's head which is broad like a cobra's	طَلَعَهَا كَأَنَّهُ رُؤُوسُ الشَّيْطَانِ
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Astrologers have also been called “شَيَاطِينُ” (*shiyateen*) in 67:5, 37:7.

Any force, according to the Quran that rebels against Allah's laws, is “شَيَاطِينُ” (*shaitaan*), whether it is man's own rebellious emotions or the leaders of nations which are opposed to Allah's system. Rebelliousness and mutiny is their basic characteristic, and their job is to obstruct the establishment of the right systems.

“شَيَاطَانُ” (*shaitaan*) and “طَاغُوتُ” (*taghoot*) are one and the same thing because “طَاغُوتُ” (*taghoot*) is anything that is non-godly (2:256, 4:76).

For more information about *shaitaan*, see heading (B-L-S) and (Ain-B-D).

Sh-Ain-B ش ع ب

“الشَّعْبُ” (*as-shobe*): to gather together and to differentiate, to split and create a gap (it has opposite meanings):

Raghib says “الشَّعْبُ” (*as-shobe*) means to gather and scatter because “الشَّعْبُ مِنَ الْوَادِي” (*ash-shobe minal waadi*) is a place where one end meets the valley, but the other end departs from it. When viewed it seems that a thing is being parted, and when you see the other ends it seems as if the two ends are meeting together. So the word means both to gather together and to separate {R}.

Ibn Faris says that it connotes collectiveness together with parting:

“الشَّعْبُ” (*ash-shobe*): big tribe, the line of descendants to which all the tribes belong. The plural is “الشُّعُوبُ” (*shu-ub*) as in 49:13. Tribe is smaller than “شَعْبٌ” (*sha'ab*),

“شُعْبَةٌ” (*shoa-bah*) means branch, or a part that has broken away, the space between two horns of branches. Plural is “شُعَبٌ” (*shu-ab*) as in 77:30.

“الشَّعْبَةُ مِنَ الشَّجَرِ” (*ash-shobatus minal shajr*): spread out branches of tree:

“الشَّعْبُ” (*asheeb*): the path between two mountains.

“شَعْبَانُ” (*shaabaan*): the month before the month of fasting (*ramadaan*). In this month the Arab gypsies use to spread out in search of water and loot {T}. Hence it also means to scatter.

“شُعَيْبٌ” (*Shoaib*): is the name of a messenger who was sent towards the nation of *Madyan*. Some say that he was *Moosa's* father-in-law {M}. For more details see heading *Shoaib*.

The Quran teaches that all mankind is one nation, one universal brother hood (2:213), but in order to be recognized, they were divided into many different races and tribes. The difference is only for recognizing them just as we give different names to our sons in order to distinguish between them. It is not to signify any superiority or bias. Therefore, no nation or tribe or caste is superior to others. All humans are respectable (17:70). The standard or rank is deed and he who is better in deeds is the more respectable.

This verse has this meaning.

29:13	Just as by dividing a city it is easier to recognize the parts so was the human race divided for recognition	وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا - إِنَّ أَكْرَمَكُمْ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ أَتَقَىٰكُمْ
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If this purpose could be served some other way then this difference would no longer be necessary. As far as ranking is concerned, it is determined by the humanism in individuals.

Sh-Ain-R ش ع ر

“شَعْرٌ” (*sha’run*) and “شَعْرٌ” (*sha-arun*): the hair that grows on a human body. A camel’s hair is called “وَبَرٌ” (*wabarun*) and a sheep’s hair is called “صُوفٌ” (*suuf*). All these three words have been used in 16:80, although *Zamkhashri* says that “شَعْرٌ” (*sha-arun*) can be used for human as well as animal hair {T}.

“الشَّعْرُ” (*ash-sheru*) and “الشَّعْرُ” (*ash-sha’ru*) is to comprehend something, to know, to judge, to understand the finer points, to comprehend something by using the senses. The verbs that are derived from it are “شَعَرَ” (*sha’ar*), “يَشْعُرُ” (*yush-ur*), “شَعَرَ” (*sha-ur*), “يَشْعُرُ” (*yash-ur*). Prominent from the nouns derived from it are “الشَّعْرُ” (*ash-sher*), “الشَّعْرُ” (*ash-sha’r*), “الشَّعُورُ” (*ash-shu’ur*), “الشَّعْرَى” (*ash-shera*).

“أَشْعَرَهُ” (*ash-ara*): told him, made him aware. Some say it means to judge or comprehend something by the senses {T}.

Mental philosophy and abstract concepts were not “شُعُورٌ” (*shu-ur*) to the Arabs. It is an *ajami* (non arab) practice which was of a Greek concept.

“شَاعِرٌ” (*shaa-ir*) or poet is called so because he comprehends meanings by using his intelligence which eludes the common man. Sometimes “شَيْعُرٌ” (*she’r*) means a lie and “شَاعِرٌ” (*shaa-ir*) means a liar. Since exaggeration is mostly present in poetry, it became a saying that the best poetry is the most exaggerated. Opponents used to call the Messenger (*pbuh*) as poet and the Quranic verses as poetry in these very meanings {T}.

“شِعَارٌ” (*shi-aar*): code words (as are used in the war).

“شِعَارُ الْحَجِّ” (*sha’ir-ul-hajja*): all those deeds performed in pilgrimage, which are done to express obedience to God. The place where these deeds are done is called “شَيْعِرَةٌ” (*mash’ar*). The plural is “شُعَاعِرٌ” (*sha-ir*).

“شِعْرَى” (*shi’ra*) is the name of a star which is seen in very hot weather and is very bright.

The Quran mentions “رَبُّ الشَّعْرَى” (*rabbush shera*) in 53:49.

In the period before the advent of Islam, some Arab tribes worshipped this star {*Lisan-ul-arab*}. But if “شِعْرَى” (*sheyra*) is taken to have come from “شَعَرَ” (*sha’ar*) then it would mean intellect and comprehension.

The Quran has mentioned intellect, comprehension, awareness, deliberation etc. at several places. By deliberating on them with reference to context, we can glean their fine differences. But all have one thing in common, that is, those who do not utilize their intellect and consciousness, are thought to be worse than animals and the fuel for *jahannam* (hellish society).

The Quran has opposed poetry but that does not mean that prose is preferable to it and poetry not. The Quran does not bother with the style of relating. By poetry it means that emotionalism which is not concerned with facts.

In surah *Yasin*, the Quran says:

36:69	We have not taught poetry to this Messenger (<i>pbuh</i>)	وَمَا عَلَّمْنَاهُ الشَّعْرَ وَمَا يَنْبَغِي لَهُ
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Neither is poetry befitting the revolution that a messenger brings. Then it says:

26:69	Whatever We have given the messenger (<i>pbuh</i>) is historical facts and life's basic principles and rules	إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ وَقُرْآنٌ مُبِينٌ
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And their purpose is:

36:70	Those who have the ability to be alive, to warn them (through the Quran about the destructive results of the wrong ways of life)	لِيُنذِرَ مَنْ كَانَ حَيًّا
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This means that the Quran is concerned with historical facts and the solid facts of life. As against it, poetry plays with man's emotions. Therefore it has likened it to a camel which is driven hither and thither by false thirst. See heading (H-Y-M). The poets traverse the land of emotions and their entire life they say what they do not practice (26:225-226). This way of life is not befitting the stature of a messenger (and his followers). According to Biographical literary by *Coleridge*, the opposite of poetry is not anti-thesis (prose), but science. The Quran argues scientifically, and therefore poetry (which is removed from facts) can not be accepted by Allah.

Here it must be noted that like other nations (the Greeks etc.) the Arabs too believed that like astrologers and fortune tellers, poets also receive divine messages. Even today poets in the west are thought to be 'inspired' people. The Quran clearly distinguishes between human capabilities and the Revelation, so that it becomes clear that direct inspiration from God can only be had through the revelation and only messengers had this. Since messenger hood has come to an end, it can not be available to anyone anymore. It gives no credence to '*kashf*' and '*ilhaam*' (both mean inspiration) and does not think them to be direct knowledge from God. It says that this 'inspiration' is actually the product of human emotionalism or the product of psychological power which have no relevance to knowledge and fact. This is why the Quran says that a messenger is not a poet, just as he is not a fortune teller, sorcerer, or astrologer. Revelation towards a messenger is from God, and it does not have any mixture of his own wishes and thoughts (53:3-4). The Arabs did not have the term '*tasawwuf*' in their language but the specialty that *tasawwuf* was thought to be present in poets, astrologers, sorcerers etc. By rejecting these elements, the Quran has actually rejected "*tasawwuf*" too. If the Arabs were familiar with the term of '*tasawwuf*', they would also say that '*tasawwuf*' is not befitting a messenger. Instead the Quran has said that a messenger is not an astrologer or sorcerer. He gets knowledge directly from God which creates revolutionary changes in man's world, but "*tasawwuf*" cannot do all this.

The Quran says about the hypocrites:

2:9	These people try to deceive God and the group of believers, but actually they are deceiving themselves, but they do not realize this	يُخَادِعُونَ اللَّهَ وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا - وَمَا يَخْدَعُونَ إِلَّا أَنفُسَهُمْ وَمَا يَشْعُرُونَ
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This means that consciously they try to deceive others but sub-consciously they are deceiving themselves. Note how well this difference between conscious and subconscious conditions has been related.

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:2	Do not desecrate the symbols of God	لَا تُلْحِقُوا شَعَائِرَ اللَّهِ
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Islam is a way of living which takes shape in the form of a state. A state has some symbols. Respecting them means that that you respect its way of life, or state like the flag of a state. The flag is actually a piece of fabrics but it is also the symbol of a state and is therefore respected. Respecting the flag means that one respects that state. These symbols are called "شَعَائِرُ" (*sha-a-ir*), therefore "شَعَائِرُ اللَّهِ" (*sha-a-irillah*) would mean the symbols of a state which is established to implement the Quranic laws.

The respect of those symbols would mean respecting the laws themselves. These symbols will not be worshipped, only respected, and that too while keeping in mind that in themselves these symbols hold no value. Their respect is the respect of God's laws, and that is that.

«الشُّعْلَةُ» (*as-sholah*): the flames of the fire. The wood or fuel which helps to flares up a fire.
 «الشَّعِيلَةُ» (*as-sha'eelah*): a dwelling on fire.
 «المَشْعَلُ» (*al-mash'al*): lamp.
 «شَعَلَ النَّارَ فِي الْخَطَبِ» (*sha-alan naara fil yaseeb*): he lighted a fire among the wood.
 «إِسْتَعْلَتِ النَّارُ» (*ishta-alatin naar*): the fire was alighted and flared up {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it means for the edges of something to fray, or when a fire flares up.

«إِسْتَعْلَى الرَّأْسُ شَيْبًا» (*ishta-alar raasu shaiba*): for white hairs to proliferate in the head and in this way the head to flare up with whiteness {M}, or for white hair to appear in the head.

In surah *Maryam*, these words have been used for *Zikria* in 19:4.

Shoaib

شعيب

One of *Ibrahim's* sons (from his third wife, *Qatura*) was named *Madyan*.

He settled in an area adjacent to north *Hijaaz* and his descendants came to be known as the nation of *Madyan*. Their period is taken to be around 2000 B.C. This nation flourished here for about four hundred years. Later *Shoaib* was sent to them. When *Moosa* had escaped from Egypt (after the murder incident) he had come to *Madyan*. The Quran says that here he lived with an old man (and his daughters) and became a shepherd. This old man married off one of his daughters to him (28:22-28, 20:40). This old man has not been described further, but some believe that it could have been *Shoaib*.

The Torah has named him *Raaweel*, and also *Yasru* as well as *Hubaab*. Historians think that *Hubaab* is indeed the name of *Shoaib* {Torah 10:29}, while these other names are of his pseudonyms and that *Hubaab* is called *Shoaib* in the Quran. This way the time of *Shoaib* and *Moosa* is the same i.e. approximately 1700 to 2000 B.C.

The Torah says *Madyan's* brother was named *Yaqshaan*. His son *Duwaan* settled near his uncle. This was a very green area and swamped by thick forests. The Quran says that *Shoaib* was sent towards the nation of *Madyan* (29:36), and *Ashabul aika* (26:176-177). Researchers think that *Ashaabul aika* were the descendants of *Duwaan*. The Quran has talked about the nation of *Madyan* and *Ashaabul aika* as if they were people of the same tribe.

From what *Shoaib* advised them, one can glean what things they were indulging into:

7:58	My nation, be obedient to Allah, be subservient no one else is your Allah except him	يَقَوْمِ اعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ - مَا لَكُمْ مِنْ إِلَهٍ غَيْرُهُ
7:58	You should measure fully (not less). Do not give people less (than they bargain for). After the country has reformed, do not bring chaos in it	فَأَوْفُوا الْكَيْلَ وَالْمِيزَانَ وَلَا تَبْخَسُوا النَّاسَ أَشْيَاءَهُمْ وَلَا تُفْسِدُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ بَعْدَ إِصْلَاحِهَا ذَلِكُمْ خَيْرٌ لَكُمْ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ مُؤْمِنِينَ

This shows that there were serious inequities in that society for removing, which *Shoaib* had been sent to them (as a messenger).

He brought his message to them and as usual, the capitalist section or the wealthy section of society opposed him strongly and warned that if he and his people did not accept their religion, they will be banished (7:88).

Surah *Hoodh* talks about one objection they made which points to a great fact about the way of Islam as well. They had said:

11:87	Shoaib, does your salah teach you to tell us to leave worshipping the gods that our forefathers worshipped, or that we can not spend our wealth as we wish?	قَالُوا يَا شُعَيْبُ أَصْلَاحُكَ تَأْمُرُكَ أَنْ نَتْرِكَ مَا يَعْبُدُ آبَاؤُنَا أَوْ أَنْ نَفْعَلَ فِي أَمْوَالِنَا مَا نَشَاءُ إِنَّكَ لَأَنْتَ الْحَلِيمُ الرَّشِيدُ
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This shows how deep the connection between *salah* and economics in Islam is. *Salah* means to follow the laws of Allah, and the laws of Allah also encompass economics. As such, *salah* and economics go hand in hand.

That nation did not reform and kept on its erring ways until it was totally destroyed.

Surah *Al-Airaaq* says:

7:91	earth shaking doom overtook them	فَأَخَذَتْهُمْ الرَّحْفَةُ
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Surah *Hoodh* mentions “الصَّيْحَةُ” (*as-saiha*). It means a harsh voice or sound.

Surah *Ash-Shora* says “يَوْمَ الظُّلَّةِ” (*yaumi zullah*) in 28:189, that is, the day of the shadow. It seems that an earthquake occurred with a deadly sound and volcanoes emitted clouds of smoke. In this way that nation was destroyed.

To understand what the relationship between physical or natural calamities and Allah’s punishment is, see the heading *Nooh* in my book “*Jooy-e-noor*”.

Sh-Gh-F ش ع ف

“الشَّغْفُ” (*as-shaghaaf*): the veil over the heart, or the membrane over the heart.

“شَغَفَهُ” (*shaghafah*): reached his heart’s veil.

“شَغَفَهُ الْحُبُّ” (*shaghafahul hoob*): love reached the veil of his heart, or love penetrated the membrane of his heart and entered in it {T}. Therefore, the height of love is also called “الشَّغْفُ” (*as-shaghaaf*) {M}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:30	Yusuf’s love penetrated her heart (into the depths of her heart)	قَدْ شَغَفَهَا حُبًّا
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Sh-Gh-L ش غ ل

“الشُّغْلُ” (*as-shughl*), “الشُّغْلُ” (*as-shughul*), “الشَّغْلُ” (*as-shaghl*), “الشَّغْلُ” (*as-shaghal*): engagement, hobby, an activity which engages one’s entire attention.

“اِشْتَغَلَ فِيهِ السَّمُّ” (*ishtaghala fihi samm*): the poison penetrated into him.

“مَالٌ مَشْغُولٌ” (*misalun mashghool*): capital invested in trade or business.

Ibn Faris says this word is opposite of “فَرَاغٌ” (*faraaghun*) which means to be empty, vacant or free.

The Quran says:

48:11	We are so much occupied in our wealth that we have no time to spare for other things.	شَعَلْنَا أَمْوَالَنَا
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Surah *Yasin* says about the dwellers of *jannah*:

36:55	They will be engaged in something happily all the time (which will be very pleasing to them)	فِي شُغْلٍ مُكِينٍ
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“شَفَعُ” (*shaf’un*) basically means to join one thing with another, or to join two things together, or to make them become a pair {M}.

“وَتَرُ” (*watrun*) means to be single and “شَفَعُ” (*shafun*) means to be part of a pair, or the former is odd and the latter even {T}.

Raghib says it means to join one thing with another similar thing or to integrate them, and “شَفَعُ” (*shaf’ah*) means to join one while helping or commiserating with him.

“شَفَاعَةُ” (*shuf’ah*) means to strive and mix something with one’s own things and thus make them additional {T}. In *Faqahi* terms, it means to pay the price of something which is asked for, and thus make it one’s own, i.e. to buy at a price {M}.

“عَيْنُ شَافِعَةٍ” (*ainun shaafi’ah*): the eye which due to lack of focus sees double.

“نَاقَةُ شَافِعٍ” (*naaqatun shafi’ah*): a she-camel who has one child following her, and a second in the womb.

“نَاقَةُ شَفْوَعٍ” (*naaqatun shafu’o*): a she- camel which gives twice as much milk as usual {T}.

“الشَّافِعُ” (*as-shaafi’o*): different types of grass which grows together {T}.

Ibn Faris says “الشَّاةُ الشَّافِيَةُ” (*ash-shatush shaafi’o*) is a goat with its kid with her.

The above meanings show that “شَفَعُ” (*shaf’un*) means for one thing to be added to another and thus make two. Later “شَفَاعَةُ” (*shaf’ah*) began to mean recommendation because in this a man stands with someone else for the recommendation or for helping him with his support {T}. It also means to pray {T}.

Ibn Faris says “شَفَعَ فُلَانٌ لِفُلَانٍ” (*shafa-a falanun lifulaan*) means a man who comes with someone and recommends whatever he wants (supports him in whatever he wants).

The Quran preaches collective life because the development of a man’s capabilities takes place only in a collective life. Thus everyone of the group of *Momineen* is the “شَفِيعُ” (*shafi*) of every other individual. That is, always there if he needs help and the centre of this system is the “شَفِيعُ” (*shafi*) of everyone. He does not let anyone feel that he is alone. This companionship is his basic characteristic.

This “شَفَاعَةُ” (*shaf’ah*) goes beyond the members of the group of *Momineen*, because it is their duty for sustenance towards the whole of mankind. They have been told to “بِرٍّ” (*birr*) and “تَقْوَىٰ” (*taqwa*). That is, to co-operate with others big heartedly, according to the laws of Allah. They are told conversely to “إِثْمٍ” (*ismun*) and “عُدْوٍ” (*udwaan*), or not to co-operate in malpractices (5:2).

It has been said as:

4:85	He who helps others in good deeds also gets his share of the benefits, and so does one get equal share of punishment if he helps someone in bad deeds	مَنْ يَشْفَعْ شَفَاعَةً حَسَنَةً يَّكُنْ لَهُ نَصِيبٌ مِنْهَا وَمَنْ يَشْفَعْ شَفَاعَةً سَيِّئَةً يَّكُنْ لَهُ كِفْلٌ مِنْهَا
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Note that in co-operation, one does help another but in *shafa-at* one is by the other’s side.

We believe that on the Day of Judgment the criminal will be judged and designated to hell. Then those who are close to God i.e. the messengers, especially messenger *Muhammed* (*pbuh*) will intervene on their behalf and God will pardon them and grant them *Jannat*. This is called *shafa-at*. It is evident that this belief demolishes the entire structure of *Deen* which is based on the consequential law, i.e. as you do so you reap.

99:7-8	every deed produces a result and is manifested	مَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ خَيْرًا يَرَهُ وَمَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ شَرًّا يَرَهُ
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It seems that the concept is a product of the era of hegemony. When the friends of the oppressive rulers recommended amnesty for the criminals and criminals were pardoned, and even rewarded. This concept

seems to be like the Christian belief and lends support to it that *Isa* (Jesus) will at last atone for the wrongs of people and thus they will be pardoned. But your Messenger (*pbuh*), it was said by them, can do nothing in this regard. Thus, in response to this, the concept of *shafa-at* came into existence, which says that after the criminals are so adjudged on the day of the judgment, our Messenger (*pbuh*) will go into bowing before God and will himself not go into *jannat* until God pardons all.

This did answer the Christians but demolished the entire structure of the *Deen* and the Muslim nation which believed this, went into ignominy. There is no such certification from the Quran, nor can there be any leeway for this. It has been said clearly:

2:48	nobody can do anything for anybody, nor will anybody <i>shahafa-at</i> be accepted nor will any body let off after paying any compensation, and nobody will be able to help the criminal	وَأَتُوا يَوْمَ لَا تَجْزِي نَفْسٌ عَنْ نَفْسٍ شَيْئًا وَلَا يُقْبَلُ مِنْهَا شَفَاعَةٌ وَلَا يُؤْخَذُ مِنْهَا عَدْلٌ وَلَا هُمْ يُنصَرُونَ
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To support the concept of *shafa-at*, such verses are presented as:

2:225	who can recommend or plead without his permission	مَنْ ذَا الَّذِي يَشْفَعُ عِنْدَهُ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِهِ
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It is concluded from this that with God's permission, recommendations can be made and the messenger *Muhammed* (*pbuh*) will recommend his followers with God's permission indeed.

But to draw these conclusions from this verse is wrong because it goes against the natural law, which runs throughout the Quran. So if the concept of recommendation or *shafa-at* is also in the same Quran then it will mean (God forbid) that the Quran has contradictions.

The verse before the one above says:

2:224	O believers, whatever Allah has given you, keep it open (available) for the sustenance of the needy, before such a time comes when neither can one pay for one's crimes and enter the <i>jannat</i> , nor will the friendship of any elder be of any advantage, and neither will anybody's <i>shafa-at</i> .	لَا يَبِيعُ فِيهِ وَلَا خُلَّةٌ وَلَا شَفَاعَةٌ
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In the next verse, if the meaning is taken to mean that Allah will accept (any) recommendation, then there will be an open contradiction, which there is none of in the Quran.

That raises the question of what this verse really mean? According to the law of nature, every deed's results begin to be formulated right from when the deed starts. In order to make one understand the truth about reward and punishment, the Quran has drawn a picture before us as if people are presented in court for judgment. There is a judge, the accused, the prosecutor, witnesses, and policemen etc. The Quran has used these as allegories. At one place in the Quran it is said that the one who is being questioned will stand alone in the witness stand.

6:95	you will be presented alone before us....there will be nobody with you (to help you or recommend you or plead for you)	وَلَقَدْ جِئْتُمُونَا فُرَادَى-- وَمَا نَرَى مَعَكُمْ شَفَعَاءَ كُمْ
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And "the policeman" (the *malaikah*) will push you from behind and bring you before Us:

50:21	everyone will have one to drive him forward: there will also be witnesses	وَجَاءَتْ كُلُّ نَفْسٍ مَعَهَا سَائِقٌ-- وَشَهِيدٌ
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These witnesses will not stand with the criminal on their own. Whoever, those who will be called, will come forward and will be allowed to present evidence. These are the "شَفِيعٌ" (*shafi-un*) which have been mentioned in the Quran.

2:255	Who can stand with anyone (support anyone) without Allah's permission	مَنْ ذَا الَّذِي يَشْفَعُ عِنْدَهُ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِهِ
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These witnesses will also be messengers who are said to be:

5:109	The day when Allah will gather the messengers together and ask them as to the response they had received from the people?	يَوْمَ يَجْمَعُ اللَّهُ الرُّسُلَ فَيَقُولُ مَاذَا أُجِبْتُمْ
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And the *Mala-ikah* too will be called to appear:

78:38	The day when the <i>arruh</i> and the <i>malaikah</i> will be standing in rows and only he will speak who has been granted permission to do so	يَوْمَ يَقُومُ الرُّوحُ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ صَفًّا لَا يَتَكَلَّمُونَ إِلَّا مَنْ أَذِنَ لَهُ الرَّحْمَنُ وَقَالَ صَوَابًا
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Therefore in these verses the meaning of *shafa-at* seems to be to give evidence. To present the right evidence for somebody is a very great help too. The Quran has explained this itself:

43:86	Those other than Allah whom they call upon have no power for <i>shafa-at</i> . Only who gives true evidence has the power to give <i>shafa-at</i> .	وَلَا يَمْلِكُ الَّذِينَ يَدْعُونَ مِنْ دُونِهِ الشَّفَاعَةَ إِلَّا مَنْ شَهِدَ بِالْحَقِّ
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That is, *shafa-at* means evidence. This is why the messenger (*pbuh*) has been called *shaheed*, or witness (16:89), but never *shafi*. About the concept of *shafa-at* which others have, the Quran has said:

74:47	The <i>shafa-at</i> or recommendations or pleadings of their recommenders will do no good	فَمَا تَنْفَعُهُمْ شَفَاعَةُ الشَّافِعِينَ
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This because Allah's law says that:

6:165	No man can lift another's burden	لَا تَزِرُ وَازِرَةٌ وِزْرَ أُخْرَىٰ
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Jannat is begotten only in exchange for good deeds:

7:43	to acquire the <i>jannat</i> (heaven) through recommendation is born in nations which have lost the will or power to do good deeds	تِلْكَمُ الْجَنَّةُ أَوْرَثُوهَا بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ
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This sort of concept prevailed among the Jews when they were at the lowest ebb. They used to say that they will not stay in *jahannam* or hell. They shall perhaps stay there for a few days (after which they will be rescued by their holy people). At this the Quran says to ask them if there is some pact about this between Allah and them. Then it says to tell them that such beliefs are false. Allah's law dictates that anyone who commits bad acts will be destroyed, and he who has faith and does good deeds will be among the heirs to the *jannat*, or heaven (2:81-82).

It is obvious from these explanations that in this world *shafa-at* would mean to be with someone to help him. If the work assisted is good, then he too will be equally rewarded, if not then he will also be punished. In the life hereafter the concept of *shafa-at* is as if a witness chooses to give true evidence. It is an allegorical statement.

For the criminals to go scot free on somebody's recommendation or *sifarish* or for someone to get what one does not deserve as such, is against the basic teachings of the Quran. Therefore, this is not the right meaning of *shafa-at*. Wherever it appears in the Quran, reference must be made to the context to determine its true meaning.

Surah *Al-Fajar* says “وَالشَّفْعِ وَالْوَتْرِ” (*wush shaf-ee wal watr*) in 89:3. It either means the stars which move together or which exist together or which move separately or exist separately. That is, the stars which seem to be together and the stars which seem separate.

“الشَّفَقُ” (*ash-shafaq*): the redness that remains in the sky from sunset till darkness falls.

“شَفَقَ” (*shafaq*) also means edge {T}.

Raghib says that “شَفَقَ” (*shafaq*) means daylight at time of sunset intermingling with the darkness of the night.

The Quran says:

84:17	But no, I sweat by the dwelling glow	فَلَا أُفْسِمُ بِالشَّفَقِ
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Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is weakness in something.

“الشَّفَقُ” (*ash-shafaq*) or “الشَّفَقَةُ” (*ash-shafaqahk*): to have apprehensions about the welfare of someone.

“أَشْفَقَ مِنْهُ” (*ash-faqa minhu*): feared it, was bothered.

“أَشْفَقَ عَلَيْهِ” (*ash-faqa alaihi*): looked after him out of love (or sympathy) and feared lest anything bad befalls him {T}. Such a well-wisher is called “مُشْفِقٌ” (*mushfiq*) or “شَفِيقٌ” (*shafiq*).

“الشَّفَقَةُ” (*al-shafaqah*) also means weakness, since fear is also weakness.

“تَوْبُ شَفَقٍ” (*saubun shafaq*): fragile cloth {M}.

Since this word signifies a weakness, it is not used for God.

Raghib says that when this word is followed by “مِنْ” (*min*), the element of fear is dominant, and when it is followed by “فِي” (*fi*), the element of love, sympathy and well-wishing is more prominent. *But Taj-ul-Uros* has used “عَلَى” (*ala*) instead of “فِي” (*fi*), and this seems more appropriate.

Surah *Al-Azaab* says:

33:72	they feared it (they were afraid of misappropriating what was trusted to them)	أَشْفَقُوا مِنْهَا
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Surah *Al-Ambia* says:

21:28	They are afraid (of the destructive results of going against the laws) and fear the results	وَهُمْ مِنْ خَشْيَتِهِ مُشْفِقُونَ
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In other words, they think it would be in their own interests to abide by these laws.

“شَفَاهُ” (*shafahu*), “عَنْهُ شَفَاهُ” (*unhu shafha*): he put him to work that made him oblivious of other things.

“شَفَاهُ” (*shafahu*): struck his lips.

“شَفَاهُ” (*shafahu*): talked to him in person.

“شَفَاةٌ” (*shafatun*) means a single lip. The pair of lips is called “شَفَتَانِ” (*shafatani*) as well as “شَفَتَيْنِ” (*shafatini*). The plural is “شَفَاهُ” (*shifah*) and “شَفَوَاتُ” (*shafawaat*) {T}.

Some scholars think that “شَفَتَيْنِ” (*shafah*) is actually from “شَفَوُ” (*shafwun*). That is why we have listed it under (Sh-F-W), which may as well be referred to there.

“الشِّفَا” (*ash-shafa*): edge, the limit of everything.

Ibn Faris says that this word may have been culled from “شَفَا” (*shafa*), which is from the root (Sh-F-W), and it is also possible that “ف” (*fa*) has been exchanged with “ب” (*ba*), that is, “شِبَا” (*shiba*) has changed into “شَفَا” (*shifa*).

When the sun is setting, they say “مَا بَقِيَ مِنْهُ إِلَّا شَفَا” (*ma baqiya minhu illa shafa*). That is, very small part of it remains {M}. This has the connotation of being near death.

“شَفَتِ الشَّمْسُ” (*shafatish shams*): the sun is about to set {T}.

The Quran says:

9:189	at the edge of the beach	عَلَى شَفَا جُرْفٍ
3:102	at the edge of the hole	شَفَا حُفْرٍ

“الشِّفَا” (*as-shafah*) means lip. The plural is “شَفَوَاتُ” (*shafawat*) and “شِفَاهُ” (*shifah*). From this it became “مُشَافَهَةٌ” (*mushafah*) i.e. to talk person to person {T}.

The Quran says:

90:9	two lips	شَفَتَيْنِ
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“شَفَا” (*shafah*), “يَشْفِي” (*bi-shafih*), “شِفَاءٌ” (*shifa-a*): gave him health (freedom from sickness). “الشِّفَاءُ” (*ash-shifa-o*) means to recover from an illness. Later it began to be used for medication and treatment too {M}.

The noble Quran has used this word as against sickness:

26:80	when i fall sick, it is he who gives me health	وَإِذَا مَرِضْتُ فَهُوَ يَشْفِينِ
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It also to mean medicine, as in:

16:69	it has recovering power for people (cure)	فِيهِ شِفَاءٌ لِلنَّاسِ
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Ibn Faris says that this root basically means to come to the edge and peep over it. He thinks that the cure overpowers the disease and that is why “شِفَاءٌ” (*shiffaa*) is called so.

“شَقَّ” (*shaqqah*), “يَشُقُّ” (*yash-uqquhu*), “شِقَاقٌ” (*shaqqa*): to tear something up, to make a hole in it.

“إِنْشَقَّ” (*inshaqq*): was torn.

“الْشَقُّ” (*ash-shaqq*): the morning {T}.

“إِنْشَقَّتِ الْعَصَا” (*inshaqqatil asa*): the elements shattered, or mutual differences cropped up.

“شَقَّ عَصَا الْمُسْلِمِينَ” (*shaqqa asal muslimen*): it created fissiparous tendencies among the group of *momineen*.

“الْمُشَاقَّةُ” (*al-mushaqqah*), “الشِّقَاقُ” (*ash shiqaaq*): opposition, enmity, mutual differences {T}.

“شَقٌّ” (*shiqq*): hard labor, problem, to become tired after exerting to the full, tiredness.

“شَقَّ عَلَيْهِ الْأَمْرُ” (*shaqqa ilaihil amr*): the matter weighed heavy on him.

“شَقَّ عَلَيْهِ” (*shaqqa alaihi*): put him in trouble {T}.

“شَقَّ عَلَيْهِ” (*ash-shuqqah*): the opposition of distance, distant journey {T} as in (9:42), or the destination which is reached with difficulty.

The Quran says “شَقَّ” (*shiqq*) to mean splitting of stones and for springs to spring forth, as break of dawn (2:74). Surah *Saad* has used “شِقَاقٍ” (*shiqaaaq*) to mean opposition, and it has been used in 59:4 for opposition and differences.

Surah *Al-Abas* says:

80:26	Then we split the earth in a physical way	ثُمَّ شَقَقْنَا الْأَرْضَ شَقَاقًا
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Surah *Al-Qasas* says:

28:27	I do not want to be harsh with you or to give you a difficult responsibility	وَمَا أُرِيدُ أَنْ أَمْلَأَ عَلَيْكَ
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Surah *An-Nahal* uses “شَقَّ” (*shiqq*) to mean hard work (16:7).

“شَقَّ” (*shaqq*) means to oppose intensity and constriction, deprivation and hopelessness. It means to adopt a different way, create a difference, to part with each other (4:35).

Surah *Al-Qamar* says:

54:1	the time of revolution neared and <i>al-qamar</i> is about to split	إِقْتَرَبَتِ السَّاعَةُ وَالشَّيْءُ الْمُنْمَرُ
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For its meaning, see heading (Q-M-R).

Sh-Q-W(Y) ش ق و (ى)

“الشَّقَاءُ” (*ash-shaqa'a*): intensity and constriction, deprivation.

“شَقِيًّا” (*shaqiya*), “يَشْقَى” (*yash-qa*), “شَقَاوَةً” (*shaqawah*), “شَقْوَةً” (*shiqwah*): to be ill fated, have bad luck. “شَقَاوَةً” (*shiqawah*) is the opposite of “سَعَادَةً” (*saa'a-dat*) or faithfulness, and since “شَقَاوَةً” (*siqawat*) has tiredness and trouble in it, that is why it also means tiredness and trouble or bother.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are intensity and to bear hard labor. It is also the opposite of facility, softness, faithfulness and good luck.

“المُشَاقَّةُ” (*al-mushaqah*): to bear trouble, to bear harshness.

“الشَّاقِي مِنَ الْجِبَالِ” (*ash-shaaqi minal jibal*): a mountain which juts out and overhangs, and which is very difficult to climb.

The Quran has said “شَقِيٍّ وَسَعِيدٍ” (*shiqiyyun wa saeed*) in 11:105. Here “شَقِيٍّ” (*shiqiyyun*) is the opposite of “سَعَادَةً” (*saa'a-dat*).

Zikriyah says in surah *Maryam*:

19:4	And I have not been deprived and hopeless in your supplication, my Sustainer.	وَلَمْ أَكُنْ بِدُعَائِكَ رَبِّ شَقِيًّا
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Surah *Taha* says:

20:2	We have not revealed the Quran to you for depriving you of life's blessings and to throw you in trouble	مَا أَنزَلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْقُرْآنَ لِتَشْقَى
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This “تَشْقَى” (*tash-qa*) has been explained a little further on where *Adam* has been told that life's necessities are plenty in this heaven (20:118), but if you listen to *Iblees*, he will cause your exit from *jannat* (20:117). The result will be that you will be deprived of all the blessings and be involved in great difficulties.

Surah *Al-Lail* says he who is “أَشْقَى” (*ash-qa*), goes to *jahannam* of great ill fate (92:15). In other words, he will be deprived of happiness, but against this has come “أَتَقَى” (*atqa*) in 92:17. Therefore “أَشْقَى” (*ash-qa*) may also mean rebellious.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:32	Insolent unblessed	جَبَّاراً شَقِيحاً
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Surah *Al-Mominoon* says about those in *jahannum* who will say:

26:106	bad luck befell us	عَلَيْتْ عَلَيْنَا شَقْوَتُنَا
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Remember that this ill fate is the result of man's own bad deeds. Good luck or bad luck is not man's destiny.

Sh-K-R ش ك ر

“الشُّكْرُ” (*ash-shukr*): to fill up and to express {M}.

Ibn Faris says it has different meanings, one of which is to be filled and abundant.

- “شَكَرَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*shakaratin naaqah*): the camel's teats became full of milk.
- “الْمَشْكَارُ” (*al-mishkaar*): an animal which may have little fodder but still its teats are full of milk.
- “ضُرَّةٌ شَكْرِيٌّ” (*zarratun shakra*): teat full of milk.
- “الشَّكْرَةُ” (*as-shikrah*): a female camel whose teats are full of milk {T}.
- “شَكَرَتِ الشَّجَرَةُ” (*shaakiraatish shajarah*): branches sprouted on the tree trunk.
- “اِسْتَكَارَتِ السَّمَاءُ” (*ishtakaratis sama-u*): it rained very hard.
- “اِسْتَكَارَ الْحَرُّ وَالْبَرْدُ” (*ishtakaral harru wal bard*): the winter and summer were fulsome.
- “شَكَرَ فُلَانٌ” (*shakara fulan*): that man was greatly benevolent and gave a lot to people.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) means obedience and the performance of must to do duties, as also the expression of thankfulness, God's full response to this “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*), or to give much in return for little.

For example if a person helps someone else a little, even at his own cost, then this little sacrifice on his part will be considered greater than giving something to someone that is more than one's necessities. This is what it means by giving ample return for little benevolence.

If we keep the basic meaning of “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) in mind, then we can easily comprehend the meaning of “سَعَى مُشْكُورٌ” (*sa-ee mushkooor*) or that effort which fetches good results. That is, more than the effort warranted, so complete like the teats of a goat which are full of milk.

“شَاكِرٌ” (*shaakir*) is one who makes one's effort fetch full results, and also the one whose efforts fetch such complete results. The word “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) has been used for the efforts going waste, against “خُسْرٌ” (*khusr*) in 39:65-66. A man's efforts which produce good results is also called “شُكُورٌ” (*shakoor*) in 14:5. “شُكُورٌ” (*shakoor*) has more exaggeration than “شَاكِرٌ” (*shaakir*).

Since “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) means to highlight or make evident. That is why “كُفْرٌ” (*kufir*) or denial has been used against it in 14:7. It is meant for covering up or bury.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:154	Always keep God given blessings uncovered or available so that the human race can benefit from it (do not hide them or cover them)	وَاشْكُرُوا لِي وَلََّا تَكْفُرُوا
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Among the first of God given gifts are the capabilities which a human being possesses. The development of capabilities and them to be evident is also “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*), and this thing is produced by doing good deeds. Therefore, good deeds become the cause of “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) of God's benevolence.

Surah *Al-Ahqaaf* relates this very fact when it is said that you should ask for:

46:15	O my nurturer, give me the capability of thanking you (for committing <i>shukr</i>) for your benevolence. (I may do such deeds as to develop them)	رَبِّ أَوْزِعْنِي أَنْ أَشْكُرَ نِعْمَتَكَ... وَأَنْ أَعْمَلَ صَالِحًا
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At another place, it is said:

31:12	He who covers up or hides Allah's benevolence (hides or does not disclose), does Allah no harm, but he who uncovers them develops his own capabilities (he harms himself). Allah in his personality needs no thanks (He is not dependent on you)	مَنْ يَشْكُرْ فَإِنَّمَا يَشْكُرُ لِنَفْسِهِ وَمَنْ كَفَرَ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ غَنِيٌّ حَمِيدٌ
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To uncover God's gifts or to disclose them means to utilize them as God has ordered. That is, they should be kept available for humanity at large. This fact has been highlighted with the help of an example. A dwelling was plentiful, but they started covering God's benefits (16:112), and the result was that they started facing punishment of hunger and fear. Allah's messenger was sent to them but they rejected him too. Then the *momineen* have been warned not to do likewise.

16:112	Keep Allah's gifts uncovered	فَكَفَرْتَ بِأَنْعَمِ اللَّهِ
16:114	If you follow his laws only, then obviously you will keep open whatever Allah has given you	وَأَشْكُرُوا نِعْمَتَ اللَّهِ

Denial of those gifts means to hide them (according to yours self made laws):

16:114	For what they used to do on their own	إِنْ كُنْتُمْ إِيَّاهُ تَعْبُدُونَ
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This has been made further clear in surah *Al-Airaaf* that “شَاكِرِينَ” (*shaakireen*) are those who do not follow the way of the *Iblees* and do not fall into his trap (7:17).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says about *Bani Israel*:

2:56	We gave your life after death so that you could be “thankful”	ثُمَّ بَعَثْنَاكُمْ مِنْ بَعْدِ مَوْتِكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَشْكُرُونَ
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This makes it clear that nations regain life or are resurrected after death so that they can develop their capabilities. Those nations which do not do so are not ‘alive’, nor can they exist.

For efforts to be thankful or “مشكور” (*mash-koor*) means for them to produce full results, that is, they produce the fullest results and become fully fruitful.

To be thankful means to uncover the blessings or gifts that God has given:

- That he makes his latent capabilities fully evident or develops them.
- Keep the means of development spread in the universe open for the benefit of mankind and not hide them for himself.

This is only possible when Allah's laws are fully followed. This will be ‘thankfulness’ of man. “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) from Allah's side means that He makes man's efforts produce full results, and it is a particularity of Allah's law that if followed, they produce the fullest possible results.

Surah *Adh-dhahar* says:

76:3	We have shown the right path through revelation. Now it is up to him (man) to adopt it, or some other way	إِنَّا هَدَيْنَاهُ السَّبِيلَ إِنَّمَا شَاكَرًا وَإِنَّمَا كَفُورًا
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Here “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) means to treat the path as a great gift and adopt it.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:147	If you value this guidance then believe (have faith or <i>eeman</i>)	إِنْ شَكَرْتُمْ وَأَمْنَتُمْ
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34:13 has used “شَكُورٌ” (*shakur*) or “شَاكِرٌ” (*shaakir*) which means to benefit from the gift you have been given.

Surah *Saba* says:

34:13	O descendants of <i>Dawud</i> . Act (according to our laws) by benefiting from the gifts given	اعْمَلُوا آلَ دَاوُدَ شُكْرًا
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That is, utilize the multiple benefits and avail of the benefits in the universe and thus be thankful for them.

Ibn Faris says it also basically means to be content with little means.

“فَرَسٌ شَكُورٌ” (*farasin shakoor*) means a horse which is fat, so even a little fodder is enough for it. When one’s capabilities are developed, then even few external supports are sufficient to produce profuse results.

Sh-K-S ش ك س

“شَكَاسَةُ الْأَخْلَاقِ” (*shakaasatul akhlaaq*): to be impolite or discourteous.

“شَاكَسَهُ” (*shakasahu*): he treated him shabbily, harshly.

“الَلَّيْلُ وَالنَّهَارُ يَتَشَاكَسَانِ” (*al-lailu wan nahaaru yatash-a kasan*): day and night are opposed to each other.

“تَتَشَاكَسُوا” (*tash-akasu*): they opposed each other, or they acted narrowly in their dealings.

The Quran says:

39:29	Partners in business who keep quarrelling as they are bad tempered and narrow minded in their dealings	شُرَكَاءٌ مُتَشَاكِسُونَ
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Sh-K-K ش ك ك

“الشَّكُّ” (*as-shak*): it is the opposite of belief.

Raghib says that when two quite different things begin to look similar to a person, then this condition is called “شَكٌّ” (*shak*).

Muheet says with reference to *Keys* that just as knowledge begins with belief, “شَكٌّ” (*shak*) begins with doubt. See heading (R-Y-B). This is why it is said “شَكٌّ مُرِيبٌ” (*shakkun mureebun*) but not “رَيْبٌ مُشَكِّكٌ” (*raibun mushakkik*)

Ibn Faris says it basically means for one thing to diffuse in another.

As such, “شَكَكْتُهُ بِالرُّمْحِ” (*shakatuhu bir rumh*) means that I pierced the spear into his body.

“شَكٌّ” (*shakk*) is like that one thing which seems to have entered another, and nothing is certain (doubt).

Raghib says that “شَكَكْتُ الشَّيْءَ” (*shakaktu shaiyi*) means that a thing which has a hole through it. A thing like that cannot be depended upon to be reliable. There is a thought that it is from a proverb which says for the arm to stick to the side. This word would therefore mean for two opposing things to enter into one another so that the distinction is no longer clear {R}.

“شَكُّوا بُيُوتَهُمْ” (*shakku buyutahum*) means that they built all their homes to be similar {T, R}.

These examples make the meaning of “شَكٌّ” (*shak*) clear. That is, for two opposite things to look similar and not be clearly distinguishable from one another. Hence it also means to be hard for a person to reach the right conclusion about something.

About the matter of crucifixion of Christ, it has been said that:

4:157	Indeed, those who differ in it, are surely in doubt about it	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ اخْتَلَفُوا فِيهِ لَفِي شَكٍّ مِنْهُ
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This makes the meaning of “شَكٌّ” (*shak*) clear, i.e. there was so much resemblance between *Isa* (Jesus) and the man they had arrested, that it was difficult to differentiate one from the other. Therefore, they are still in doubt as to what had actually happened. Details can be found in my book “*Shola-e-mastoor*” in the subject of *Isa*.

Sh-K-L

ش ك ل

“الشُّكْلُ” (*ash-shikl*), “الشَّكْلُ” (*ash-shakal*), “الشُّكْلُ” (*ash-shukal*): similar, alike.
 “فِي فُلَانٍ شَكْلٌ مِنْ أَبِيهِ” (*fi fulanun shaklin min abih*): that man resembles his father very much {T}.

Surah *Saad* says:

38:58	Various punishments of the same kind	وَأَخْرَجَ مِنْ شَكْلِهِ أَتْرَاجَ
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The plural is “أَشْكَالٌ” (*ash-kaal*) which means different matters and needs.
 “شَكْلَ الْأَمْرِ” (*shakalal amr*): the matter became complex and dubious {T}.
 “الشَّكَالُ” (*ash-shikaal*): the rope with which an animal’s fore and hind legs are secured so that it can only take measured steps as the rope’s leeway allows.
 “شَكْلَ الدَّابَّةِ” (*shakalad dabbah*): he bound the legs of the animal with “شَكَالٌ” (*shikaal*)

Ibn Faris says that most meanings of this word are derived from similarity and likeness. He says “شَكَلْتُ” (*shakalat*) is so said because one leg of the animal is secured to a similar leg.

“الشَّكَالُ فِي الرَّحْلِ” (*ash-shikaalun fir rahl*): the rope with which the camel’s seat ends are tied {T}.
 “شَاكِلُنْ” (*shaakilun*) has come from it, the feminine of which is “شَاكِلَةٌ” (*shaakilah*) as in 17:84, that is which binds.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:84	Say that each works on its manner	قُلْ كُلٌّ يَعْمَلُ عَلَى شَاكِلِيهِ
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To comprehend the meaning of this verse, we first have to understand that everything has potential. A mango seed has the capability to grow into a mango tree and bear sweet fruit. But although the cactus seed also turns into a tree, it bears only needles. The inner destiny of a mango seed is the fruit of the mango, while that of the cactus tree are the thorns.

Like the animal which cannot go beyond or above its “شَاكِلَةٌ” (*shaakilah*), so can nothing go beyond its inherent limits. Nothing can go beyond the limit nature has proscribed for it. As far as man is concerned, he too has limited “شَاكِلَةٌ” (*shaakila*), but death is not his limit. He can go beyond it (55:33). Heredity, initial environment, upbringing, education, emotional leanings etc. are the shackles which arrest his feet, but the right kind of society can produce vastness in his scope.

The Quran formulates a system which gives every man the chance to develop his latent capabilities and talents. The prohibitions in such a society are there only in order to create this expansiveness (2:286). In a Quranic society, everyone will be held accountable according to his “شَاكِلَةٌ” (*shaakilah*), although his limits will also be tried to be extended. The climax of an animal’s progeny is that it becomes like its father, but the human child can go much farther than his fore fathers. Modern day science is testimony to the fact that today man is much ahead of his forefathers. The next generation will be much advanced than the present generation. Just like the capabilities of men differ in any era, so do the possibilities of different generations of man differ, and their possibilities increase as their knowledge and awareness increases. Note that these possibilities are present in everybody’s personality, which are equal.

Lataif-ul-lugha says that “الشَّوَاكِلُ” (*ash-shawakil*), which is the plural of “شَاكِلَةٌ” (*shaakilah*) means the roads which lead from the main highway {T}. This is referring to the different ways of life men adopt according to their capabilities.

Humans have the power to do as they like, but their powers are limited. For instance, a man can raise one foot and keep standing but he cannot raise both feet and still keep standing. In so far as they have the power to exercise their right, they are totally independent and there is no interference in it what so ever. See details in the heading (Q-D-R).

Sh-K-W(Y) ش ك و (ى)

“شَكْوَةٌ” (*shakwah*) means a leather bag with an opening at one end, used for holding water or milk.
 “شَكْوٌ” (*shakwun*) means to open the opening so that whatever it holds comes out or becomes evident. This leads to “شِكَايَةٌ” (*shikayah*) i.e. to come out with whatever one may have in his heart {T}.

Raghib says it means to make one’s displeasing thoughts known.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:86	I relate or express my troubles to my Allah.	إِنَّمَا أَشْكُو بَثِّي وَخُزْنِي إِلَى اللَّهِ
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At another place it is said:

58:1	She was relating her condition to Allah	وَتَشْتَكِي إِلَى اللَّهِ
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“الْمِشْكَاةُ” (*al-mishkaat*): a hole in the wall which is not through that wall. Some have said it means a place where lamps are kept (24:35).
 “الشَّكْوَى” (*ash-shakwa*): complaint {T}.

Sh-M-T ش م ت

“شَمِيتَ الْعَدُوَّ وَشَمَاتَهُ” (*shamital aduwu shumatah*): for someone’s enemy to be happy at one’s plight:
 “أَشْمَتُهُ بِعَدُوِّهِ” (*ash-matahu bi-aduwvih*): made him happy by hurting or troubling his enemy: {T}.

When in anger *Moosa* dragged his brother by his heard. His brother *Haroon* had said:

7:150	do not give the opponents a chance to be happy at my expense or to laugh at me	فَلَا تُشْمِتْ بِيَ الْأَعْدَاءَ
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“الْتَّشْمِيتُ” (*at-tash-mit*) means to pray for somebody who sneeze. Like saying “bless you”, or to remove this “شَمَاتَتِ” (*shumatat*) by one’s prayer, like “تَمْرِيطُ” (*tamreez*) means to remove sickness from someone:

Sh-M-Kh ش م خ

“شَمَخَ الْجَبَلُ” (*shamakhal jabal*): for a mountain to be very high and long.
 “الْجِبَالُ الشَّوَامِكُ” (*al-jibalu-shawamikh*): very high and long mountains.
 “شَمَخَ الرَّجُلُ بِأَنْفِهِ” (*shamakhar rajulu bi-anfehi*): The man raised his nose (high in the air): showed pride: {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris says the root means to be big and high.

The Quran says:

22:77	big mountains that are firmly in their place	رَوَاسِيَ شَامِخَاتٍ
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“الشَّمَزُ” (*ash-shamz*): for the human palate to be displeased or revolted with unpleasant things.

“تَشَمَزَ وَجْهَهُ” (*tash-ammaz wajhu*): his face distorted, changed colour.

“إِشْمَازٌ” (*ash-maazz*): to fear and be uneasy, for hair to stand on its end in fear, to stand, to be stifled, to feel constricted.

“إِشْمَازُ الشَّيْءِ” (*ishmaazash-shaiyi*): he dislikes that thing.

“الْمُشْمِزُ” (*almushma-izz*): to dislike: one who dislikes: one who is frightened. {T, M, R}.

Surah *Az-Zumr* says:

39:45	When only Allah is mentioned before those who do not believe, their hearts become constricted	إِذَا ذُكِرَ اللَّهُ وَحْدَهُ اشْمَأَزَّتْ قُلُوبُ الَّذِينَ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْآخِرَةِ
39:35	when others (except Allah) are mentioned, they get very happy	وَإِذَا ذُكِرَ الَّذِينَ مِنْ دُونِهِ إِذَاهُمْ يَسْتَبْشِرُونَ

Happy with personality cults and pure obedience to Allah is only displeasing to him, because men can easily be won over by emotions but law makes concessions for no one. The system or law that the Quran has chosen for mankind seeks only to obey Allah and no one else. Personality cults have no place in this system, but personality cults have so distorted Allah's *Deen* that a human being is the last word nowadays on anything. The law of Allah as the final authority has no place in this system! This has extended to that stage that if anyone is invited to only follow Allah, he becomes displeased! This is the great truth which the Quran points to in the above verse.

“الشَّمْسُ” (*ash-shams*): the sun: 2:285 the sunlight.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be of different colours, to be fickle, and transient.

“الشَّمُوسُ مِنَ الدَّوَابِّ” (*ash-shamusu mid dawaab*): the four legged animal which is uneasy.

“الشَّمْسُ” (*ash-shams*) is used for the sun because it keeps on moving along with its heat which is not constant.

76:13	They will neither feel the sun, or freezing cold	لَا يَرَوْنَ فِيهَا شَمْسًا وَلَا زَمْهَرِيرًا
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“مَطْلَعُ الشَّمْسِ” (*matli-ash-shams*): is the place from where the sun seems to be rising, or the east (18:90).

“مَغْرِبُ الشَّمْسِ” (*maghrib ash-shams*): the spot at which the sun seems to be setting, or the west (18:86).

Gharib-ul-Quran says that the sun was the national symbol of the Persians just as the moon was the national symbol of the Arabs before Islam {*Mirza Abul Fazal*}. For these meanings of the sun and the moon, see heading (Q-M-R).

Ibn Kalbi says that “الشَّمْسُ” (*ash-shams*) is the name of an ancient idol {F}. Probably that is why the Arabs of old, named their boys *Shams*. Some think that it was the name of a famous water spring {F}.

“الشِّمَالُ” (*ash-shimaal*): the left side. It is the opposite of “يَمِينٌ” (*yameen*), or right side (18:17).
 “يُمْنٌ” (*yumnu*): a symbol of happy tidings.
 “الشِّمَالُ” (*ash-shimaal*): the sign of ill fate.
 “زَجَرْتُ لَهُ ظَيْرَ الشِّمَالِ” (*zajaratun lahu twairush shimaal*): I scolded the bird of his ill-fate {T}.

The Quran says “أَصْحَابُ الشِّمَالِ” (*ash-abush shimaal*) in 56:41, meaning the fellowship of the ill-fated ones. It has appeared to mean those who live in *jahannam* (hellish environment). These are the people who will be given the list of their deeds in their left hand (69:25).

“الشِّمَالُ” (*ash-shamaal*): the north wind which is usually very cold. This wind is cold and dry and if it blows for more than a week, the undertakers get ready for brisk business because the Egyptians could not tolerate the wind for long {T}.

“الشِّمَالُ” (*ash-shimaal*) also means the cover that is put on the teats of the goat (to protect them from other's eyes).
 “الشِّمْلَةُ” (*ash-shamlah*): is the blanket in which a man wraps himself {T}.

Raghib has said that “شِمَالٌ” (*shimal*) is used for that cloth in which something gets wrapped from left.
 “الِشْتِمَالُ بِالنُّوبِ” (*ishtimaalu bis saub*): is to be wrapped up in cloth in a way that its end is to the left {R}.
 “إِشْتَمَلَ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*ishtamala alash-shaiyi*) means to overshadow something and include it in itself {M}.

According to *Ibn Faris*, this above mentioned is included in its basic meaning.

“الرَّحِمُ تَشْتَمِلُ عَلَى الْوَلَدِ” (*ar-rahimu tash-tamilu alal wald*): the womb encompasses the child or has taken the child within it.

6:145	that which is in the wombs of the mothers	أَمَّا اسْتَمَلَتْ عَلَيْهِ أَرْحَامُ الْأُنثَيَيْنِ
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Habit and temperament is also called “الشِّمَالُ” (*ash-shimaal*). Plural is “شِمَائِلُ” (*shamaa-il*). We have already said that “يَمِينٌ” (*yameen*) means symbol of happiness and “شِمَالٌ” (*shimal*) the symbol of ill fate. The Quran has termed those in hellish environment as “أَصْحَابُ الشِّمَالِ” (*as-haabish shimaal*) and those in heaven as “أَصْحَابُ الْيَمِينِ” (*as-haabul yameen*). This does not mean that the Quran also believed or accepted these symbols as the Arabs in those days did. Since the Quran has been revealed in the Arabic language, it uses the metaphors of that language to express its meaning clearly. This point should always be kept in mind that the Quran did not believe in things like the Arabs did, but only used the terms of their language so that it would be easier for them to understand.

“شَنَاءٌ” (*shana-ah*): to be dead against somebody {T, R, M}.

Muheet says it involves enmity with rudeness.

The Quran says:

5:2	Some nation's strong enmity	شَنَاءُ قَوْمٍ
108:3	your enemies (those who had enmity with you)	إِنَّ شَانِئَكَ هُوَ الْأَبْتَرُ

Ibn Faris says the root of the word contains the connotations of having enmity and of avoiding.

“الشَّهَبُ” (*ash-shahab*): white colour with a blackish tinge, just like the flame of the fire which in intense heat seems white with a blackish centre, or a mountain covered with snow.

“سَنَةٌ شَهْبَاءٌ” (*sanatun shah-baa*): a drought year with no greenery to be seen and the land seems white and barren.

“شِهَابٌ” (*shihaab*): the flame of fire which rises, or the flame which is seen till afar in the sky. It is called a broken star {*T, R*}.

In the old ages (dark ages) it was thought that man's luck or destiny was connected with the stars, and therefore astrologers traced the movement of the stars to find out about man's destiny. This is practiced even now and astrologers are given much importance. The Quran says that when the world was less knowledgeable, such things (astrology) could be accepted, but when the light of knowledge has come, then such guess work is not tolerable. If somebody makes such claims these days (as astrology does) then they should be dispelled by the whip of knowledge, which discloses the myth of such predictions (72:9, 37:9, 15:18).

“شَهَدَ” (*shaheda*), “يُشْهِدُ” (*yush-hud*) means to be present, to present one.

“شَهَادَةٌ” (*shahadah*): to present truthfully whatever is known to one through actual viewing or through insight {*T, R*}. One who does this is called “شَهِيدٌ” (*shahid*) or “شَهِيدٌ” (*shaheed*).

“مُشَاهِدَةٌ” (*mushahidah*) means to observe, according to scholars, but if the meaning is stretched then it would mean for anything to come within the grasp of the senses.

The word “غَيْبٌ” (*ghaib*) has come against “شَهَادَةٌ” (*shahadah*) in 59:22.

“غَيْبٌ” (*ghaib*) means that which is oblivious to the eyes, invisible. See heading (Gh-Y-B).

As such, “شَهَادَةٌ” (*shahadah*) would mean things which can be seen and felt and “غَيْبٌ” (*ghaib*) would mean those things or forces which are latent. So “شَهَادَةٌ” (*shadah*) or “مُشْهُودٌ” (*mash-hoodh*) are those things and forces which appear as palpable realities. “غَايِبُ الْفَرَسِ” (*ghaibul fars*) is that force of the horse which it preserves while running and “شَاهِدُ الْفَرَسِ” (*shahidul fars*) is the strength which he uses up in running. “شَاهِدٌ” (*shahida*) also means to be at home and “غَائِبٌ” (*ghaab*) means to go away on a journey. {*Lane*}.

2:185	Those of you who are traveling (in the midst of travel) should fast in this month	فَمَنْ شَهِدَ مِنْكُمُ الشَّهْرَ فَلْيَصُمْهُ
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Travellers have a different set of orders.

“إِمْرَأَةٌ مُشْهِدٌ” (*imra atun mush-hid*): a woman whose husband is not at home {*T, R*}.

“مُشْهِدٌ” (*mush-hud*): the place one presents oneself, or the place where all hidden results appear palpably (19:37).

“يَوْمٌ مُشْهُودٌ” (*yaumun mash-hoodh*): means such time (11:103).

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:87	Indeed the forthcoming of the Quran teachings have appeared in palpable form	إِنَّ قُرْآنَ الْفَجْرِ كَانَ مَشْهُودًا
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Here “مُشْهُودٌ” (*mash-hoodh*) means that the results appear in palpable form. About the meaning of “فَجْرٌ” (*fajr*), see heading of that name.

“شُهِدَاءُكُمْ” (*shuhada akum*): your helpers (2:23).

God has been called “شَهِيدٌ” (*shaheed*) because everything is before him to witness (22:17) and a messenger is a “شَهِيدٌ” (*shahid*) as well (28:2), because the facts that he sees as a messenger, he unveils exactly before others. This is a main function of messenger-hood.

“الشَّهْدُ” (*ash-shahd*), “الشَّوْهْدُ” (*ash-shohd*): honey which is not yet taken out of the hive.

“شَهِدَ” (*shahida*) means to give evidence, be a witness and to swear:

“شَهِدَ عَلَيْهِمْ” (*shahida alaihim*): 41:21 will give evidence against them:

“شَهِدَ عَلَى كَذَا” (*shahida ala kaaza*): also means to give full report or news about someone {M, *Arab-ul-Muwarid*} {T, R}.

Gharib-ul-Quran (with reference to *Ibn Abbas*) says that “شَهِدَ” (*shahida*) also means to decide as in 12:21, or one who decides, as in 6:19. It also means watchman (2:143).

Whatever the form this word takes the meanings include the sense of being present, to present, to keep within sight, in all of them.

The Quran has not used the term “شَهِيدٌ” (*shaheed*) for those who give their lives in the way of god. Such a man has not been described by the Quran as “شَهِيدٌ” (*shaheed*). Even a man alive, as well as a dead man can be “شَهِيدٌ” (*shaheed*). Anybody who by practical example, gives evidence of “مَا أَمَنَ بِهِ” (*ma amana behi*), what he believes, is a “شَهِيدٌ” (*shaheed*), whether it is through life, or wealth, or with any other thing, and stays steadfast with it for his entire life. To give one’s life in the way of God is the biggest evidence of one’s belief.

According to the Quran (2:143), the entire nation of Muslims is “شُهِدَاءُ عَلَى النَّاسِ” (*shuhada’a alan naas*), i.e. the nation that kept watch over all the nations of the world, and their centre (Rusool), acts as safe keeper of their deeds (2:143). Recall the duty of the nation of Muslims of yours, and the high stature it enjoyed for this responsibility and then compare that to the nation of Muslims of today. Today we are dependent on others for the barest needs. The reason of this is obvious. That nation of before considered the Quran as its code of life and acted upon it, but we seem to have been lost in superstitions and myths.

Sh-He-R

ش ه ر

Taj-ul-Uros says that “الشُّهْرَةُ” (*ash-shohrah*) means for a bad thing to be famous or well known.

Johri says it means for something to become known completely. In the urdu language, “شہرت” (*shohrat*) is used for good things to become famous, and “تَشْهِيرُ” (*tash-heet*) for bad things to be famous.

“الشَّهِيرُ” (*ash-shaheer*): famous, respected {T}.

“الشَّهْرُ” (*ash-shahru*) means the moon because it heralds the advent of a month. A month is also called “شَهِرٌ” (*shahr*).

Ibn Faris says that it basically means to be evident and clear. This is probably why the moon is also called “الشَّهْرُ” (*ash-shahar*).

“شَاهِرُهُ مُشَاهَرَةً” (*shaharahu mushaharah*): employed him at a monthly salary {T}.

The Quran says “شَهْرُ رَمَضَانَ” (*shahru ramazan*) in 2:185, where this word has appeared for the month of *Ramadan*.

The plural is “أَشْهُرٌ” (*ash-har*) and “شُهُورٌ” (*shuhur*), as in 9:36.

“شَهَقَ الرَّجُلُ” (*shahaqar rajul*), “يَشْهَقُ” (*yash-haq*), “شَهَقًا” (*shaheeqa*): the sound of the voice of his crying came out of his chest haltingly.

“شَهَقُ الْحِمَارِ وَتَشَاهُقُهُ” (*shaheequl aari wa tash-ahaquh*): the sound of a donkey braying.

“الشُّهُوقُ” (*ash-shuhuq*): to rise.

“الشَّهَقَةُ” (*ash-shahqah*): a scream {T, R}.

The Quran says:

11:106	to shout and make a din	زَفِيرٌ وَشَهَقٌ
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Zajaaj says this word means the voices of people in plight, and “شَهَقٌ” (*shaheeq*) means a loud sound of crying in pain. This word is from “جَبَلٌ شَاهِقٌ” (*jabalun shahiq*) which means a very high mountain, climbing which is very difficult {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be high.

“فُلَانٌ ذُو شَاهِقٍ” (*fulana zu shahiq*) means that he is very hot tempered.

The Quran has also used the word “شَهَقٌ” (*shaheeq*) to mean *jahannam* (hellish environment) in 67:7. In such a hellish society, there is chaos, cries and shouts everywhere, whether it is hell in this world or the hereafter.

“شَهَاهُ” (*shahu*), “أَشْتَاهُ” (*ashtahah*): to wish for something, to lean towards it, desire it.

Raghib says that “شَهْوَةٌ” (*shah-watun*) means temptation towards the things one wants or likes.

Sometimes a thing which is wanted is called “شَهْوَةٌ” (*shahwah*) as well and sometimes this emotion is called “شَهْوَةٌ” (*shahwah*) {T}.

“شَيْءٌ شَهِيٌّ” (*shaiyi shaiyyun*): tasty thing.

“طَعَامٌ شَهِيٌّ” (*tayamun shahi-yun*): the food that one likes {M}.

In the verse (3:13) “شَهَوَاتٌ” (*sahahawatun*) is the plural of “شَهْوَةٌ” (*shahwah*) which according to *Raghib* means goods that are liked (3:13).

Muheet says that “الشَّهَوَاتُ” (*shahawaat*) is an exaggeration meaning.

“مُشْتَهِيَاتٌ” (*mushtahiyat*) means favourite things or leanings (27:56). Along with other words, it has appeared for sexual leanings.

The Quran has described life of *jannat* as:

41:31	Every good thing will be available there (whatever your heart desires).	وَلَكُمْ فِيهَا مَاتَشْتَهُونَ أَنْفُسَكُمْ
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Surah *Maryam* says:

19:59	After that such people came who shunned <i>salawaat</i> and pursued sexual interests.	فَخَلَفَ مِنْ بَعْدِهِمْ خَلْفٌ أَضَاعُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَاتَّبَعُوا الشَّهَوَاتِ
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This means that instead of following Allah's laws, they started pursuing their temptations and wishes. If human desires are met under the laws of the revelation then the pleasantries of a heavenly life are begotten. Instead, if the laws of revelation are broken, and such desires are met, then the result is destruction. Also see heading (H-W-Y).

“الشَّوْبُ” (*ash-shaub*): to mix together.

“شَابَ الشَّيْءُ شَوْبًا” (*shaabash shaiyi shauba*): he mixed that thing, he adulterated that thing.

From this “الشَّوْبَةُ” (*ash-shaub*) came to mean deception.

“الشَّوَابُ” (*ash-shawa-ibu*): is the plural of “شَائِبَةٌ” (*shaa-ibah*) which means the adulterations, the faults, and dangers.

“شَوْبٌ” (*shaub*) also means honey because it also is mixed with wax, and it is also mixed with herbs for medication {T, M, R}.

The Quran says about those in *jahannam*:

37:67	On top of it, they will be given hot mixture (to drink)	إِنَّ لَهُمْ عَلَيْهَا لَشَوْبًا مِنْ حَرِّهِمْ
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This means that they will have unpleasant environment, troublesome existence, life full of difficulties, deceitful existence.

“شَارَ الْعَسَلُ” (*shaaral asal*): took the honey out of the hive and collected it.

“الْمِشَارُ” (*al-mash'ar*): the hive out of which the honey is taken.

“الشَّوْرُ” (*as-shaur*): the honey which is taken out of the hive.

“الْمِشْوَارُ” (*al-mishwaar*): the stick which is used to take the honey out (of the hive).

“الْمِشْوَارَةُ” (*al-mishwaarah*): the honeycomb.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to make evident or present, and to take something away.

“شَاوَرُوا” (*shawar*), “مُشَاوَرَةٌ” (*mushawarah*), “تَشَاوَرُوا” (*tash-awar*): to consult mutually, to get the gist of others' opinions and arrive at a conclusion {R}. Hence it means deposition of the thoughts, opinions etc. so that the opinions may lead to some conclusion.

If it is taken to mean honey itself, then it would mean to collect all the honey from the hive.

The string of a bidder's bow is also called “الْمِشْوَارُ” (*al-mishwaar*) {T}.

As such the principal for “مشوره” (*mashwarah*), or consultation would be the thrashing of opinions and then reaching a conclusion through them.

“أَشَارَ إِلَيْهِ” (*ash-aaral ilaih*): pointed to him {T}. (19:29).

“الشَّوْرَةُ” (*ash-shaurah*), “الشَّارَةُ” (*ash-harah*): beauty, style, dress, clothing, plumpness, look, adornment.

“شَارَ” (*shaara*), “يَشُورُ” (*yash-oor*): trained the horse or made it run in order to display it to a customer. {T}.

The Quran has given laws for the humanity, which are never changing. A Quranic system is one in which people formulate sub laws by consultation according to needs of their times under the broader framework of these laws.

That is why it is said about the *Momineen*:

42:38	their matters will be decided by mutual consultation	وَأَمْرُهُمْ شُورَى بَيْنَهُمْ
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Since the first ever Quranic system was established by the Messenger (*pbuh*) himself, he was told:

3:158	Consult these Momineen in such matters	شَاوِرْهُمْ فِي الْأَمْرِ
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Since the consultation is for all *Momineen*, their system can never be rigid or static. They can, with mutual consultation, not only amend old laws but also make new sub laws in keeping with the needs of their times. Thus while the never changing laws of Quran will always be constant, the sub laws will keep

changing from time to time. This is what Quran means by consultation. The Messenger (*pbuh*) himself did this, and the Quran is testimony to it. Therefore all *Momineen* of all times are supposed to do this (4:115). In the western style of governance, nothing is changeable. The nation is free to decide what it wants. They do not have to follow any parameters.

It is called the secular form of governance. In the other hand, the fundamentalists think that nothing is changeable and the decisions that have been made some time back should always hold. Contrary to both, the Quranic system says that the basic unchangeable laws are that of the Revelation, and staying within their parameters sub laws can be changed with consultation as per the need of the times. This is a very good mix of permanence and change, and human life will be able to progress smoothly in this manner.

Sh-W-Ze ش و ظ

“الشَّوْاطُ” (*ash-shawaaz*), “الشَّوْاطُ” (*ash-shiwaaz*): flame which has no smoke {T, M, R}. These words also mean the heat of the fire and smoke, the heat of the sun, to shout and cry, and the intensity of thirst.

The Quran says:

55:35	a fiery flame will be sent towards your two groups	يُرْسَلُ عَلَيْكُمَا شَوْاطُ مِنْ نَّارٍ
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Sh-W-K ش و ك

“الشَّوْكَةُ” (*ash-shaukah*): the cutting of a tree, or a weapon as in 8:7.

“أَرْضٌ شَاكَّةٌ” (*ardun shaakah*): land of thorns.

“الشَّوْكََةُ مِنَ الْقِتَالِ” (*ash-shaukatu minal qitaal*): the intensity of battle.

“شَوْكَةُ السَّلَاحِ” (*shaukatus silaah*): the sharpness of a weapon. {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris says it means for something to be rough as well as to be sharp and pointed.

Sh-W-Y ش و ي

“شَوَّى اللَّحْمُ” (*shawil lahma*), “يَشْوِيهِ شَيْئًا” (*ashwihi shaiya*): to fry meat.

“الشَّوَاءُ” (*ash-shiwa'u*): fried meat or barbequed meat.

“شَوَّى الْمَاءَ يَشْوِيهِ” (*shawil ma-a yash-wih*): he heated the water, or boiled it.

“أَشْوَى الْقَمْحُ” (*ash-wal qamh*): the wheat grains became so hard that they could be brought out by rubbing between the bare hands and to fry them {T, M}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:29	which will burn their faces or singe their faces	يَشْوِي الْوُجُوهُ
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“الشَّوَى” (*ash-shawa*): means the skin of the hands and legs and the skull. Singular is “شَوَاءٌ” (*shawah*).

Some think that all the parts of the body which if hit, do not cause death are “شَوَى” (*shawah*). Thus a non-crucial or valueless thing is also called “شَوَى” (*shawah*).

Surah *Al-Ma'arij* says about the fire of *jahannam*:

70:16	It pulls out the hands and legs perforce	نَزَاعَةً لِّلشَّوَى
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This means that it makes people completely helpless, or that it pulls the skin of the head. It means both ignominy and plight, or that which robs of strength and cripples.

Ibn Faris says it means an ordinary thing or valueless thing.

“شاء” (*sha’a*), “يشاء” (*yasha’u*), “شيء” (*shaiya*), “مشيئة” (*mashiyah*): to intend.

Most scholars have not differentiated between will and intent, but there is a difference.

“مشيئة” (*mashiyat*) or will, means to invent or create and intend means to want {*T*, *M*}.

Raghib says that “الشيء” (*ash-shaiyi*) can be used for anything which is present, whether it is present physically or otherwise. “شيء” (*shaiyi*) can also be used for anything which can be known about or about which some news can be given {*R*}.

Scholars have argued a lot as to what are things that “شيء” (*shaiyi*) can be used for. Some even say that things which are hidden or latent can also be said to be “شيء” (*shaiyi*). But we will not go into the academic discussion here because the Quran is not about academic disagreements.

The Quran has said at various places:

2:20	Indeed, Allah is ordinator on every thing	إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ
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Here “شيء” (*shaiyi*) means thing, or matter, or issue or affair.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:48	(the day) when nobody can be of help to anybody	لَا تَجْزِي نَفْسٌ عَنْ نَفْسٍ شَيْئًا
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It must be understood as to what is meant by Allah’s will. We think that for Allah to have power over all things is that He acts without any law or rule like a despot, that He may grant estates if He is happy, and annihilate a whole village if He is angry at something (God forbid) {*T*}, {*M*}, {*R*}.

For details about God being all powerful, see heading (Q-D-R). For now, let it suffice to say that for God being all powerful the above meaning is quite wrong. For God’s will does not mean that it is exercised without any law or rule (or justification).

It is scientific observation that everything is bound by the system of cause and effect, but if we go backwards from this, a point will surely come when we will have to acknowledge that there is some effect which has no discernible cause. This is the point where everything in the universe and the universe itself began according to purely God’s will. If somebody inquires as to why and how this universe was created by God, he can only be answered that all this was made as per God’s will. At this point, as we believe, His will is not restricted or bound by any law or rule (the law and rule is as He willed).

36:82	At this point God says be, and the thing comes into being	إِنَّمَا أَمْرُهُ إِذَا أَرَادَ شَيْئًا أَنْ يَقُولَ لَهُ كُنْ فَيَكُونُ
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“Say” does not mean that God utters the words from his mouth, i.e. He simply intends and that thing starts being created. When we observe, we find that everything in the universe follows a certain law or rule. At this point God has subjected everything to certain laws:

33:39	here everything starts following the law that god has made for these things in the first phase of creation	وَكَانَ أَمْرُ اللَّهِ قَدَرًا مَقْدُورًا
65:3	Allah has fixed a law or rule or standard for everything	قَدْ جَعَلَ اللَّهُ لِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدْرًا

All these laws of nature have been made by Allah, but He has decided not to interfere in them:

33:61	you will never find change in Allah’s rules	لَنْ تَجِدَ لِسُنَّةِ اللَّهِ تَبْدِيلًا
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Here Allah's "مشيت" (*mashiyat*) or will would mean the laws that are being followed in the entire universe, and nothing in the universe has the power to go against these laws. The first phase (of creation) in which all laws were created by Allah as per His will alone, is out of our comprehension and we can't and do not know anything about it. Whatever we can learn about Allah is through studying these laws which are at work in the universe. In other words, this phase of Allah's will can be understood by us through knowledge and experience.

God has given man the power to obey or disobey the laws that have been created for this life:

18:29	Whosoever wishes can adopt the path of acceptance and whoever wants can choose denial	فَمَنْ شَاءَ فَلْيُؤْمِنْ وَمَنْ شَاءَ فَلْيُكْفُرْ
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That is, contrary to other creations in the universe, man can exercise the right to obey or disobey the laws that have been made for him, but at the same time he has been told that while he can indeed choose whichever way he wants, he has no power over the results. The result of every deed will be as has been created by Allah, i.e. good result for good deeds and bad result for bad deeds. For instance, man can choose between eating poison and sugar but he cannot create the result eating sugar while eating poison. The laws as to which deed will produce what sort of results have been given to man through the revelation, which today are safe in the Quran. So when man wants to understand something about Allah, he will have to understand the laws of nature along with the laws created for him. When man deliberates on both these laws, then he can get to the truth that both these laws are actually branches of the same tree.

Wherever in the Quran has been said "مشيت" (*mashiyat*) i.e. "as Allah wills", it will have to be seen with reference to the context as to which phase of His will is being talked about. To take the same meaning everywhere would create confusion due to which one may wrongly believe that it is the Quran which is contradictory! It does not have any contradiction. Our own lack of understanding creates the confusion and contradiction.

The Quran also says in 2:142 "يَهْدِي مَنْ يَشَاءُ" (*yahdi mun yash-a*). It clearly means that Allah gives guidance to whosoever so wishes. "مَنْ يَشَاءُ" (*mun yash-a*) means whichever person wants, but if it is taken to mean whoever Allah wishes, as it is generally understood, then it would mean that guidance from Allah is received by whoever He wants.

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:16	Allah grants guidance through this Quran to anybody who wants to follow its laws	يَهْدِي بِهِ اللَّهُ مَنِ اتَّبَعَ رِضْوَانَهُ
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The thing is very clear that the guidance will come from Allah, no doubt, but the initiative will have to be man's i.e. he must want it. If man follows Allah's laws, he will get guidance to the right path, but if he rejects them or goes against them then he will definitely meet destruction.

61:5	When they adopted the crooked ways (wrong ways), their hearts were also turned.	فَلَمَّا رَاغُوا أَزَاغَ اللَّهُ قُلُوبَهُمْ
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This fact has been displayed or clarified in another way. The *Bani Israel* demanded a commander. Allah appointed *Taloot* as their commander. *Bani Israel* objected to his appointment as they thought there was no outstanding-ness as to wealth. The messenger told them that *Taloot* was selected because of sagacity and bodily strength, i.e. they were told in other words that Allah's selection is not random, but well thought out and as per a certain law.

Whatever is received by anyone is because he deserves it:

2:247	Power and statehood is received from Allah according to his law (his will or certain scheme), not blindly.	زَادَهُ تَسْطِطَةً فِي الْعِلْمِ وَالْجِسْمِ وَاللَّهُ يُؤْتِي مُلْكَهُ مَنْ يَشَاءُ
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This also clarifies the meaning of surah *Aal-e-Imran's* verse which says:

3:25	Receiving power and statehood and losing them depends on Allah's scheme, or will	تُؤْتِي الْمُلْكَ مَنْ تَشَاءُ وَتَنْزِعُ الْمُلْكَ مِمَّنْ تَشَاءُ--
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That is, all this happens according to a law which is based on the principle that he, who deserves power and authority to rule, gets it (21:105). He who loses this capability loses them.

The above explanations show that there are three phases of Allah's will or scheme. The first phase in which laws for all things are created and everything is created according to His plan, or as He sees fit. We cannot comprehend anything about this phase. The second phase is that of the external universe where everything is bound to follow the laws made for it. These do not change ever. Man can find out (he has been given the capability) about these laws by deliberation. The third phase is that of the human world. In one part of his life, (the physical part) the same laws apply as to other things in the universe, but on the human level, the laws that he needs, are given through divine revelation. These laws too are not changeable but man, contrary to other things in the universe, has been given the right (power) either to follow them or go against them, but the results of his deeds, whatever they may be, will definitely be according to his deeds i.e. good results for good deeds and bad results for bad deeds (as per god's plan).

This is what is known as the turn of events, law of nature, which too is not changeable.

This is what is meant by god's "مشيت" (*mashiyat*), or will. Do note that the space, in which man has been given freedom to choose, is never interfered in by Allah. And he has been told:

41:40	In this phase, do as you wish. We will not interfere.	اعْمَلُوا مَا شِئْتُمْ
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Although the results of whatever you do will be according to the laws of nature. There is one verse which causes confusion because of its right meaning not being explained.

Surah *Ad-Dahar* says:

76:29	This noble Quran is a reminder, and anyone who wants may obey Allah	إِنَّ هَذِهِ تَذْكِرَةٌ فَمَنْ شَاءَ اتَّخَذْ إِلَىٰ رَبِّهِ سَبِيلًا
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Up to this point the meaning is very clear, i.e. the revelation has been given by Allah, now whosoever wants, can adopt the way suggested by it, and whoever wants can adopt some other way. Ahead it is said:

76:30	and you cannot want that which god does not want (general translation)	وَمَا تَشَاءُ وَاِنْ اَنْ يَشَاءَ اللّٰهُ
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This meaning is not only contradictory to what has been said before but it also demolishes the entire structure of human freedom. This would mean that whatever you wish is not your own decision but Allah makes you do what He wants, and that man is helpless in this regard.

Aside from surah *Ad-Dahar*, more or less the same verse has also appeared in surah *Al-Mudassar* (74:54-56) and surah *At-Takweer* (81:28-29). "مَا تَشَاءُ وَنَ" (*ma tash-aoon*) means 'you do not want', but according to the Arabic grammar, it also means "no, do not do it".

Mukhtasiral maani says in page 232 that the speaker wants that it may so happen, or the speaker wants to avoid a direct order (and wants the other to do what he wishes), or says this in order to instigate the other (to do it), because the one spoken to does not want to belie the speaker.

Zamkhishri has explained this point in his book *Kishaaf*.

Surah *Al-baqrah* (2:83) says that you cannot want that which God does not want (general translation) Here "لَا تَعْبُدُونَ" (*la ta'badoon*) does not mean a negative. The translation of the verse is:

"When we made *Bani Israel* agree that they will not follow anyone except Allah, and be in good behaviour with parents, and orphans and needy". After that it is said "be nice (kind) to people".

Here these words are taken in a negative term, like “تَذَبُّبٌ إِلَى فُلَانٍ” (*tazhabu ila fulanan*) or “تَقُولُ لَهُ كَذَا” (*taqulu lahu kaza*). Here “تَذَبُّبٌ” (*tazhab*) and “تَقُولُ” (*tazaru*) are pronouns but they mean ‘do it’. It is further written that this style is more effective than giving a direct order to do or not to do.

There are other examples too of this style in the Quran, for instance, the same surah says:

2:227	do not spend, except in the way of Allah	وَمَا تُنْفِقُوا إِلَّا ابْتِغَاءَ وَجْهِ اللَّهِ
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In the light of these explanations, the meaning of “وَمَا تَشَاءُ وَنَ إِلَّا أَنْ يَشَاءَ اللَّهُ” (*wama tash-aaona illa un yash-a allah*) becomes clear i.e. “you should homogenize your intent with Ours”. In other words “You should live according to Our principles, and We want you to live according to Our principles”.

Surah *Az-Zumr* says:

39:7	If you go against his laws (what harm can you bring to him i.e., nothing. He is not dependant on you at all)	إِنْ تَكْفُرُوا فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ غَنِيٌّ عَنْكُمْ
39:7	But He does not like denial from His followers. He wants you to be thankful.	وَلَا يَرْضَى لِعِبَادِهِ الْكُفْرَ - وَإِنْ تَشْكُرُوا يَرْضَاهُمْ

As such, a man must willingly accept and homogenise with Allah’s will or “مشييت” (*mashiyat*).

Sh-Y-B ش ي ب

“الشَّيْبُ” (*ash-sheeb*): old age, white hair or the whiteness of the hair {T, M}.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:4	The head due to whiteness of the hair (seems aflame)	وَأَشْتَعَلَ الرَّأْسُ شَيْبًا
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Or it means white hair has appeared in abundance in the head.

Surah *Ar-Room* uses “شَيْبَةً” (*shaibah*) for old age (30:54).

Surah *Al-Muzammil* says:

73:17	The day whose difficulty will turn the young ones old	يَجْعَلُ الْوِلْدَانَ شِيبًا
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Ibn Faris says it basically means for one thing to be mixed with another.

“شَيْبٌ” (*shaib*) is called so because in it the whiteness of the hair mixes with the blackness of the hair.

Sh-Y-Kh ش ي خ

“الشَّيْخُ” (*ash-sheikh*): an old man, an old camel, a teacher, a scholar, a leader, head of a tribe, expert.

“الشَّيْخَةُ” (*ash-shaikhah*): old woman etc.

“الشَّيْخُوخَةُ” (*shaiku khah*): old age {T, M}.

The Quran has used the word “شَيْخٌ” (*sheikh*) in 11:72 and 12:78 to mean old man, but has not used “الشَّيْخَةُ” (*ash-shaikhah*) anywhere. “الشَّيْخُ” (*ash-shaikh*) and “الشَّيْخَةُ” (*ash-shaikhah*) is nowhere to be found in the Arabic dictionaries to mean married man or married woman.

“شَادَ الْبِنَاءَ” (*shaadal bana-a*), “يَشِيدُهُ” (*yash-ee-duhu*), “شَيْدَهُ” (*shaiyaduhu*): to plaster a building and raise it higher.
 “الشَّيْدُ” (*ash-sheed*): the material (limestone etc.) with is used to plaster the building.
 “الْمَشِيدُ” (*al-masheed*): the building which is made of limestone etc. and raised high, solid, and strong {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

22:45	to raise the voice	قَصْرٍ مَشِيدٍ
4:78	high and mighty forts	الْإِشَادَةُ

Ibn Faris says the root means to raise something higher.

“شَاعَ الْخَبَرُ فِي النَّاسِ” (*sha-al khabaru fin naas*): the news spread among the people {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

22:19	the people who want dirty things to spread.	إِنَّ لِّلَّذِينَ يُحِبُّونَ أَنْ تَشِيعَ الْفَاحِشَةُ
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“هَذَا شَيْعٌ بِذَا” (*haaza shaiyu haza*): it is like, similar to {*T, M*}.

Surah *Saba* says:

34:54	like it was done with people like them	كَمَا فُعِلَ بِأَشْيَاعِهِمْ مِنْ قَبْلُ
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Surah *Al-Qamar* says:

54:51	we have annihilated people like you	وَلَقَدْ أَهْلَكْنَا أَشْيَاعَكُمْ
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“الشَّيَاغُ” (*ash-shiya'u*): the flute or voice of the shepherd with which he calls together the spread out animals of the flock. Those who give a call, invites {*T, M*}. It also means to follow behind the caller.

“شَيَّعَهُ عَلَى رَأْيِهِ” (*shayyi-ahu ala raabihi*): he followed his opinion, supported him.
 “هَذَا شَيْعٌ بِذَا” (*haaza shiyu haaza*): this is the child who was born after that child. This is said for two children who were born one after the other and no child was born in between them.
 “الْمَشَايِعُ” (*al-mushaa-iyu*): one who is always found with someone or attached to someone.
 “شَيْعُ نِسَاءٍ” (*shaiyun nisaa-un*) means one who is always found among women.
 “الشَّاعَةُ” (*ash-sha'atuh*) means wife, because she is always with her husband {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to help one another.

These meanings explain what “شَيْعَةٌ” (*shiyah*) means. That is, the people who become one party by following the same person, and thus be one another's strength and support. If it is obedience of Allah's law (which they all are following) in which there is co-operation in good deeds, then it is a party of the *Momineen*, to be with whom is a matter of pride and honour.

As such, after talking about the *Momineen* of the nation of *Nooh*, it is said:

37:83	Verily, <i>Ibrahim</i> was one of them (their successor)	إِنَّ مِنْ شَيْعَتِهِ لَا إِبرَاهِيمَ
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But if such grouping is made in obedience of some human idol, then the Quran calls it *shirk*. Therefore, it has told the Muslim nation very clearly:

3:103	All of you attach yourself to this book and do not be divided into sects	وَأَعْتَصِمُوا بِحَبْلِ اللَّهِ جَمِيعًا وَلَا تَفَرَّقُوا
30:32	Do not be like those people who have divided themselves into sects and formed groups. (do not turn into <i>mushrik</i> once you have accepted Islam).	وَلَا تَكُونُوا مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ - مِنَ الَّذِينَ فَرَّقُوا دِينَهُمْ وَكَانُوا شِيعًا - كُلُّ حِزْبٍ بِمَا لَدَيْهِمْ فَرِحُونَ

The result is that every sect claims and believes to be on the right path while all other sects (in its opinion) are not. Since Quran prohibits sectarianism itself, there is no question as to which sect is right and which wrong. Sectarianism, according to the Quran is *shirk*. That is why the Messenger (*pbuh*) has been told:

6:159	Those who forms groups in <i>Deen</i> , you have no connection with them	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ فَرَّقُوا دِينَهُمْ وَكَانُوا شِيعًا لَسْتَ مِنْهُمْ فِي شَيْءٍ
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Since there are so many groups today among the Muslims, how can they all be united? The method to eliminate the differences among these sects is suggested by Quran itself. It says to consider the book of Allah as the centre and to establish a system according to it. This is the only way. By doing so, the sects will dissipate by themselves. If personalities are removed from within, and only one system (according to the Quran is followed) then the sects will be forced to perish. To follow the Quran is very important. To follow Allah according to what one individually believes creates sectarianism. If only Allah's system is followed then it maintains unity. This may be kept in mind that sectarianism is not only division in religion but also in politics, not only among the *Momineen*, but in every nation. Sectarianism and grouping in politics too has been prohibited by Allah, and termed as punishment (6:65). The Quran has said that the Pharaoh (*Firouni*) authority or the oppressive forces always divides and rules (28:4). For more details, see heading (F-R-Q).

The Quran has termed “شِيْعٌ” (*shiya-un*) to mean nations or tribes (15:10).

LUGHAT-UL-QURAN

Dictionary of Quran

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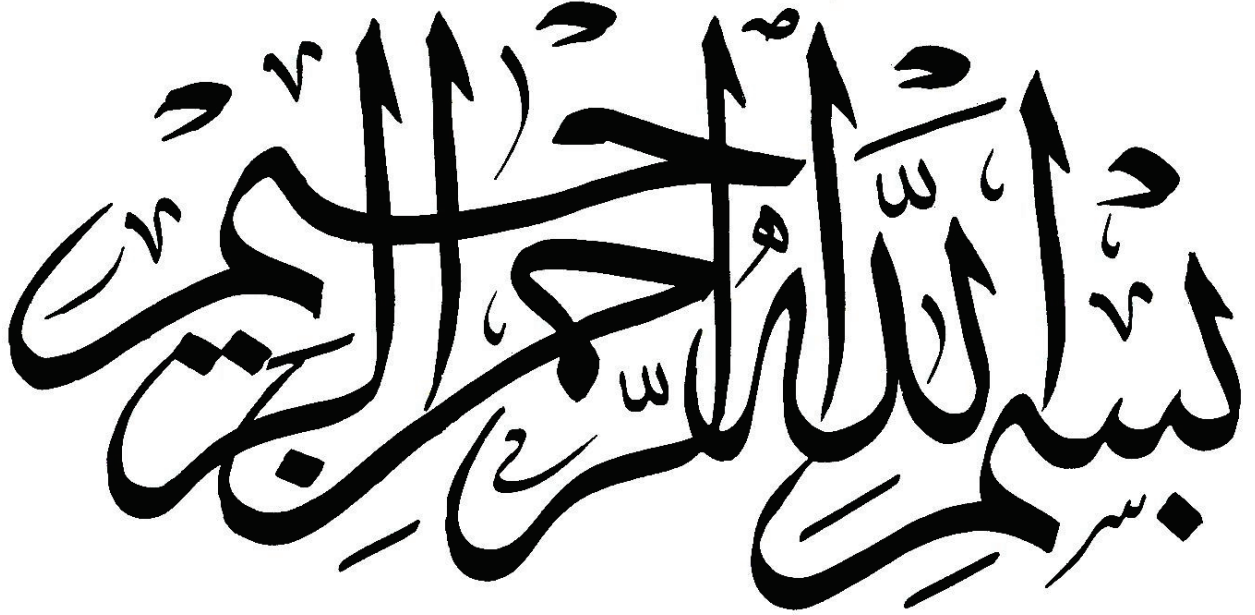
VOLUME III

Ebook edition

Originally compiled in Urdu by
Allama Ghulam Ahmad Parwez

Edited/Translated by:
Sheraz Akhtar - Quranic Education Society Norway

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Author: Ghulam Ahmad Parwez

Translator and editor: Sheraz Akhtar

Published by: Quranic Education Society, Oslo - Norway

In association with Tolu-e-Islam Trust, Lahore - Pakistan

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It is the title of the messenger *Yunus* (Jonah) as used in (68:48). For details, see heading “*Yunus*”.

Saleh

صَالِحٌ

Among the Semitic tribes who had established their governments in the interior of Arabia, the most famous was the tribe of *Thamud*. The time of its peak is that of *Aad* the First. See heading *Hud*. This nation ruled the north eastern part of Arabia called the Valley of *Qara*. *Hijr* was its capitol which was situated on the ancient highway running from *Hijaz* to *Syria*. This region was very fertile (26:146-147). They used to build castles in the valleys and strong forts at the edge of the mountains which were masterpieces of sculpture (7:74).

Saleh, who was one of them, and was made a messenger for this nation (7:73). He brought the same divine message to them as *Nooh* (Noah) and *Hud* before him had brought to their own people respectively. See headings *Nooh* and *Hud*).

7:73	My people obey God. No one except Him is your God	يَقُومُوا عِبَادُوا اللَّهَ مَا لَكُمْ مِنْ إِلَهٍ غَيْرُهُ
7:74	do not rebel and spread chaos in the country	لَا تَعْثَوْا فِي الْأَرْضِ مُفْسِدِينَ

As usual, the chiefs of the nation were arrogant full of false pride, and hence opposed this invitation to the message (7:75)

In those days, grazing lands, sheep, herds and springs were considered big sources of wealth. The rich and powerful were wont to reserve the grazing lands and springs for their own animals, and the animals of the poor died of hunger and thirst.

Saleh told his people that the springs and grazing fields should not be restricted to the use of one class, but should be available to all. It was such a reasonable request that they, the powerful people, had no answer for it. Thus they had to agree that it would be so.

Saleh told them that the practical way to do it would be to fix turns so that everyone had his turn and nobody was unjustly treated. They had to agree on this too. Then he presented a female camel and said that it belonged to Allah (as a symbol) and its turn should be fixed as well. If it was allowed to drink on its turn then it would be proved that the powerful people were sincere in their agreement. If they maltreated it, then it would prove that they were still following their old ways (7:73). The rich conspired, planned and killed the camel (7:77) and Allah's wrath, in the form of lightning and earthquake, destroyed them (7:78).

How physical catastrophes like storms, flood, hurricanes, earthquakes etc. turn into “Allah's curse”, can be understood from heading *Nooh* in the book titled “*Jooy-e-Noor*”.

Sd-B-A

ص ب أ

“صَبَاً” (*saba*), “يَصْبَاً” (*yasba*): to leave one way of life and join another.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to appear and be evident.

“صَبَانَابُ التَّعِيرِ” (*saba naabul ba-ir*): the camel sprouted budding teeth.

“صَبَاً عَلَيْهِ” (*saba alaih*): mutiny against someone and to be one's enemy.

“صَبَاً النَّجْمُ” (*saba un najam*): the star rose: can be seen {T}.

“الصَّابِئُونَ” (*assa-iboon*): those who enter another way of life by exiting one {T}.

According to **Muheet**, a **Christian** sect respected the stars as the **Muslims** respect the **Ka'bah**.

Some think that this splinter Christian sect was actually star worshipers believing in other gods than Allah.

The author of **Al-Manar** is also of the same opinion, although he also thinks that this sect believed in the famous messengers, but their beliefs were very vague {**Tafseer-ul-Manar**}.

The Quran has mentioned the “صَابِئِينَ” (**Sabaeen**) in (2:62). **Raghib** says that they used to follow Messenger **Nooh**.

Hastings' Encyclopedia of Religions and Ethics says that **Elkesaites** was another name of **Sabaeans**. **Elkesaites** was a Jewish sect which became prominent around the first century B.C. To absolve of sins they used to take baptism. Therefore the Arabs used to call them **mughtasla**, i.e. those who bathe.

The Essene sect of the Jews adopted this modern trend. Some researchers think that during the Fourth Century B.C. the nation around the Dead Sea was called **Elkesati**, or **Sampsense** or **Sampsite**. These people believed in one God and used to wash their hands and faces and bathe before worshipping.

The word means “like the sun”. It is said that the **Elkesaites** were astrologers and had therefore special interest in the stars. At the time of the revelation of the Quran, the Arabs knew this nation well and used to call them “صَابِئِينَ” (**saaibeen**), perhaps because it was believed that **Elkesaites** had entrusted their Holy book to one who was called **Sobiai**. That is perhaps why they were called **Sabians** or for their practice of baptism with water because in the **Arami** language, this is what it meant.

Sd-B-B

ص ب ب

“صَبَّ الْمَاءُ” (**sabbal ma'**): he spilled the water from above.

“فَصَبَّ” (**fasabb**): as such the water was spilled. A little liquid that remains in the jug.

“الصَّبَابَةُ” (**as-sabaab**): the slope of a spring or of the road or its lower part.

“الصَّبْبُ” (**asabbu**): the people traversed the slope.

“أَصْبَوْا” (**subbar rajul**): the man was finished {**T, R**}.

The Quran says:

80:25	We made it rain from above	أَنَّا صَبَبْنَا الْمَاءَ صَبًّا
89:13	Your Sustainer lashed them with the whip of His punishment	فَصَبَّ عَلَيْهِمْ رَبُّكَ سَوْطَ عَذَابٍ
22:16	Boiling hot water will be drooped from over their heads. (Their stiff (proud) heads will be made to bow and their pride will be destroyed)	يُصَبُّ مِنْ فَوْقِ رُءُوسِهِمُ الْحَمِيمُ

Sd-B-H

ص ب ح

Ibn Faris says that “الصُّبْحُ” (**assubh**) means a basic color out of many colours.

Some say it means red color and “صُبْحُ” (**subh**) i.e. morning, is called so because of the reddish color we see in the sky at dawn.

“مِصْبَاحُ” (**misbah**): a lantern because it too is red (because of its flame).

“الصُّبْحُ” (**as-subh**): dawn or the initial part of the day {**T**}

Raghib says it means the part of the day when the horizon is reddish created by the rising sun.

“صَبَاحُ” (**sabah**) and “إِصْبَاحُ” (**isbah**) also mean the same thing.

Ibn Faris says that “صَبَاحُ” (**sabah**) means daylight.

The Quran has used all three words as in (6:97), (37:177) and (81:18).
 “مُصْبِحٌ” (*musbeeh*): that which enters in the morning {T}.

15:83	as soon as it was dawn, a harsh sound enveloped them	فَأَخَذَتْهُمُ الصَّيْحَةُ مُصْبِحِينَ
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“الْمُصْبِاحُ” (*al-misbaah*): a lamp, as well as a flame {T} as used in (24:35). Plural is “مَصَابِيحُ” (*masabeeh*) which also means stars.

“صَبَّحَ” (*sabbah*): to reach somebody in the morning (54:38).

“أَصْبَحَ” (*asbah*): it happened, as in same sense as “كَانَ” (*kaana*) and “سَارَ” (*saar*).

“أَصْبَحَ فُلَانٌ عَالِمًا” (*asbaha fulanun aalima*): that man became a scholar {T}

5:30	he became one of the losers	فَأَصْبَحَ مِنَ الْخَاسِرِينَ
3:102	you became brothers (due to guidance of the Quran)	فَأَصْبَحْتُمْ بِنِعْمَتِهِ إِخْوَانًا

As said above, “أَصْبَحَ” (*asbah*) means “it happened”, but it seems that it means “it became”.

Sd-B-R ص ب ر

“صَبِرَ” (*sabr*) means for someone to keep striving persistently for the achievement of a desired goal {T}. As such, its basic meaning holds the connotations of stability, firmness, and continuous struggle.

“الصَّابِرُ” (*as-sabir*): the cloud which is static and does not move e.g. for 24 hours. A mountain is called so as is firmly established and does not move {T}.

“الْأَصْبِرَةُ” (*al-asbeera*): flock which return to their owners (after grazing the whole day) and do not stay away from them {L}, {T}.

“الصَّبَارَةُ” (*as-sibaarah*): a piece of wood or metal which is static in one place.

“الصَّابُورَةُ” (*as-saaboora*): a stone which is kept in the boat to maintain the balance {M}. This makes the meaning of “صَبِرَ” (*sabr*) clear. Since this action produces desired balance, it is called sabr.

“الصُّبْرَةُ” (*as-subrah*): heap of grains {T} which has not been measured. Consider as to how much hard work and persistent effort is needed to produce a heap of grains. Due to its meaning of steadfastness it also got into use as a meaning to prevent someone (from doing something).

Ibn Faris says its meanings include to imprison someone, or to make someone the target for arrows after tying him up.

“يَمِينُ الصَّبْرِ” (*yamiyanis sabr*) is the promise which somebody is forced to make {T}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says “فَمَا أَصْبَرْتُمْ عَلَى النَّارِ” (*asbarahum alun naar*) in (2:175). One meaning could be as to how much strength (resistance) they possess against fire. What is that thing which has forced them to withstand the punishment of *Jahannam* (the fire of hell)? Obviously these meanings have the connotation of courage.

The Quran says that *Bani Israel* said to *Moosa*:

2:61	we cannot bear one sort of meal all the time	لَنْ نَصْبِرَ عَلَى طَعَامٍ وَاحِدٍ
2:250	Our Sustainer, grant us power of being resolute and make our actions firm.	رَبَّنَا اقْرِضْ عَلَيْنَا صَبْرًا وَ ثَبِّتْ أَقْدَامَنَا

Here “ثَبِّتْ أَقْدَامَنَا” (*sabbat aqdaamana*) clearly explains the meaning of “صَبِرَ” (*sabr*), that is, to be steadfast.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* defines as to what “صَابِرِينَ” (*saabireen*) mean:

3:145	In the way of Allah, whatever difficulties they have to face, they neither slow down nor weaken nor become overpowered	فَمَا وَ هَلْ أَمَّا أَصَابَهُمْ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَ مَا ضَعُفُوا وَ مَا اسْتَكَاثُوا
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In (3:146), it is again likened to “تَبَتُّ أَقْدَامَنَا” (*sabbat aqdaamina*).

Surah *Al-Furqan* says that deniers used to say that this messenger is leading us astray from our idols:

25:42	if we had not resolutely kept worshipping them (the idols)	لَوْلَا أَنْ صَبَرْنَا عَلَيْهَا
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The same meaning is given in Surah *Saad*:

38:6	And be consistent towards your gods	وَاصْبِرُوا عَلَى آلِهَتِكُمْ
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“صَبَرْنَا” (*sabarna*) has been used against “جَزَعْنَا” (*jazi’na*) in (14:20), where later means to cut the rope from the center. Hence “صَبَرٌ” (*sabr*) would mean to do something continuously.

Surah *Al-Kahf* and Surah Hujrat also use the word “صَبَرٌ” (*sabr*) in the context that we sometime refer to being impatient e.g. “why are you being so impatient?”. (18:68, 49:5).

Surah *Al-Anfaal* declares:

8:65	even if 20 of you resolutely face them then you will overpower 200 of them	إِنْ يَكُنْ مِنْكُمْ عَشْرُونَ صَابِرُونَ يَغْلِبُوا مِائَتِينَ
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They have been called:

2:177	And those who are resolute through suffering and hardship	الصَّابِرِينَ فِي الْبَأْسَاءِ وَالضَّرَاءِ
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Surah *Maryam* says:

19:65	Follow God with steadfastness and stability.	وَاصْطَبِرْ لِعِبَادَتِهِ
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This has been described as:

2:153	for the full development of your capabilities utilize <i>sabr</i> and <i>salaat</i>	اسْتَعِينُوا بِالصَّبْرِ وَالصَّلَاةِ
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After that it is said:

2:157	God grants victory to those who struggle with steadfastness and resolution for their aims and face all challenges resolutely and continuously. These are the <i>saabir</i> people	أُولَئِكَ عَلَيْهِمْ صَلَوَاتٌ مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ وَرَحْمَةٌ
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This is the Quranic meaning of “صَبَرٌ” (*sabr*). The meanings that are usually taken by us (in the Urdu language) are the opposite. We take “صَبَرٌ” (*sabr*) to mean helplessness and forbear the oppression of the oppressors quietly and shed tears at it.

As such, in complete helplessness we are wont to say “All right, go ahead, do what you please, what can I do except be patient”, and this is the patience we are told to exercise as according to them there is no other way than to be patient. This means that “صَبَرٌ” (*sabr*) generally means abject helplessness and be content with one’s deprivation and reconcile to status quo.

Note how the meaning of a word changes with a change in perspective. The Quranic meaning of “صَبَرٌ” (*sabr*) is to face challenges of life resolutely and never to give up, while wrong meaning of “صَبَرٌ” (*sabr*) is rendering oneself helpless.

In summary, “صَبَرٌ” (*sabr*) means to remain engaged resolutely in the pursuit of righteous deeds and to face the difficulties on the way with courage and steadfastness so that one’s feet remain well established and firm and do not waver.

The Quran has told the Momineen:

3:200	Be steadfast and consistent	إِصْبِرُوا وَصَابِرُوا
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“إِصْبِرُوا” (*isbiru*) means to be steadfast and courageous in one’s work and

“صَابِرُوا” (*saabiru*) means to compete in resoluteness and surpass each other in it, or to excel others in resoluteness or to help each other’s resoluteness.

No nation in the world can progress if it does not become “الصَّابِرُ” (*as-saabir*) in accordance with the Quranic meaning. Whichever group of people is content with the generally misunderstood meaning of “الصَّابِرُ” (*as-saabir*) cannot make progress.

Sd-B-Ain ص ب ع

“إِصْبَعُ” (*isbaa*) means finger, or the upper part of the finger. Plural is “أَصَابِعُ” (*asabi’a*) as in (2:19).

2:19	he pointed with his finger toward another man (for guidance)	صَبَّعَ فَلَانًا عَلَى فُلَانٍ
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Sd-B-Gh ص ب غ

“الصَّبْغُ” (*as-sabgh*) basically means change or to bring a change.
 “الصَّبْغُ” (*as-sabgh*) and “الصَّبَاغُ” (*as-sibaagh*) mean anything with which a cloth or something is colored.
 “صَبَّغَ الثَّوْبَ” (*sabaghas saub*) means to color cloth.
 “الصَّبَاغُ” (*as-sabbaagh*): means a man who colors cloth.
 “كَذَّابٌ” (*kazzaab*): someone who colors his talk with exaggeration and lies.

“الصَّبْغَةُ” (*as-sibghah*): the method of coloring. It also means way of life or community {T}.
 “صَبَّغَ يَدَهُ بِالْمَاءِ” (*sabagha yadahu bil maa’i*): he dipped his hand into the water (for coloring the cloth).
 “صَبَّغَ فَلَانًا فِي النَّعِيمِ” (*sabagha fulanun fin naeem*): so and so man was flooded with benefits.

Curry is also called “صَبْغُ” (*sibgh*) because bread is dipped into it for eating {T} (23:20).

The Christians dip their children into water, or spread color on them for Baptism.
 This is called “صَبْغَةُ” (*sibgha*) or “إِصْطِبَاغٌ” (*istibaagh*) {T}.

The Quran says: ‘Allah’s color, what other color can be more beautiful and balanced’ and then it says to adopt the permanent values:

2:138	And follow the permanent values as directed.	وَتَّخِذْ لَهُ عِبَادُونَ
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But what is the meaning of Allah’s color? The rest of the verse seems to answer this question.

“وَتَّخِذْ لَهُ عِبَادُونَ” (*nahnu lahu aabedoon*) as used in 2:138 means to fully adopt the laws of Allah. The way color permeates the warp and weft of the cloth and completely changes its color, by homogenizing with Allah’s laws there is a basic change in human life and this change permeates his thinking and one transforms into a completely ‘different’ human being. In other words, his latent capabilities start becoming developed and Godly traits begin to be reflected in him. Just like Allah’s opposing traits never clash with each other but are quite balanced, so those opposing traits also begin to be found in man with complete balance. This thing is only possible within a society (not in isolation). Therefore the color of Allah is not something which can be attained in isolation or through spiritual meditation in some hideout. It is the name of living a life in Quranic society, that is, in a society based on the Quranic values.

2:138	and their result is that they get changed in Allah’s color	تَّخِذْ لَهُ مُسْلِمُونَ- تَّخِذْ لَهُ عَابِدُونَ
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Ibn Qateebah says it means the way of Allah (*Deen*) {*Al-Qartain* Vol.1 page 63}.

“الصَّبْوَةُ” (*as-sabwah*): the foolishness of teen ages, like having a crush.
 “صَبَّتِ النَّخْلَةَ” (*sabatin nakhlah*): female date palm leaned towards the distant male date palm.
 “أَصْبَتْهُ الْمَرْأَةُ” (*asbathal mar’ah*): the woman enticed the man and made him like her.
 “الصَّبِيءُ” (*as-sabiyyi*): a child which has not stopped suckling, or a kid who is not yet an adult.
 “صَبَّافُلَانُ يَصْبُو” (*saba fulanin yasbu*): that man was attracted to that thing and started acting like a child {*T, R*}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:33	(so that) I become attracted to them and start acting like teen agers (not mature)	أَصْبُ إِلَيْهِمْ
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Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to attract or be attracted, to make one bow, or to bow self. Another basic meaning is of young attraction, i.e. not to be attracted or pulled towards a thing after due deliberation, but because of childlike emotion.

“صَحِبَ” (*sahib*) means for a thing to be attached to another.
 “أَصْحَبْتُ الشَّيْءَ” (*as-habtuhul shaiyi*): I attached something to that thing.
 “صَحِبَهُ” (*sa-hibah*): he stayed with him. When a man of lower rank stays with a man of higher rank, it is said “إِنَّهُ صَاحِبٌ أَلَا عَلَى” (*innahu sahibal aala*). As against this, a man of higher rank staying with someone of lower rank will not be called “مُصَاحِبٌ” (*masahib*), even if they live together.
 “الصُّحْبَةُ” (*as-sohbatu*) and “الْمُصَاحَبَةُ” (*al-musahibatu*) mean to stay with someone. The difference here is that this stay should be for a long period. If this stay is not for a long duration, it will be called “اجْتِمَاعٌ” (*ijtima*) {*T, R*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to stay with someone or to stay near someone.

“أَصْحَبَ الرَّجُلُ وَلَهُ” (*as habar rajula walahu*) means he became obedient to that man.
 “الْمُصَاحِبُ” (*al-musaahib*): one who always stays firm, obedient and faithful {*T, R*}.
 “أَصْحَبَ فُلَانًا” (*ashaba fulaana*): protected him.

The Quran says:

21:43	None can protect them from Our punishment	وَلَا هُمْ مَنَّا يَصْحَبُونَ
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“الصَّاحِبُ” (*as-sahib*) with plural form “أَصْحَابُ” (*as-haab*) is one who stays with someone continuously. It means an owner of a thing or a person who has the right to spend or use something {*T, M, R*}. The wife has been called “صَاحِبَةٌ” (*saahibah*) because she stays with her husband (4:102).

The Quran has used “أَصْحَابُ النَّارِ” (*as-haabun naar*) and “أَصْحَابُ الْجَنَّةِ” (*as-habul jannah*). The word “أَصْحَابُ” (*as-haab*) points to the reality that *jannat* (paradise) and *jahannam* (hell) i.e. these are not physical abodes but states of the self which define inner scales of development of an individual which will always stay with him.

These are the basic meanings of “صَحِبَ” (*sahiba*).

“أَصْحَابُ الْمَيْمَنَةِ” (*as-haabul maimanah*) in (56:8) i.e. those who are at peace and successful while “أَصْحَابُ” (*as-haab*) “الْمَشْأَمَةِ” (*as-haabul mash’amah*): those who are in trouble due to their deeds (56:9).

Surah *Az-Zaariyat* says:

51:59	people like them	أَصْحَابِهِمْ
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Raghib says that “صَاحِبٌ” (*sahib*) is said for anyone who stays with a person or animal or house or time, whether this togetherness is physically or conceptually.

“صَاحِبُ الْخُوتِ” (*saahibul huut*) means fisherman as used in (68:48), i.e. with whom the fish incident happened, i.e. “ذَ النَّوْنِ” (*zannoon*) as in (21:87).

The Quran has referred to many such examples e.g. “أَصْحَابُ الْفِيلِ” (*as-haabul fiil*), “أَصْحَابُ الْأُخْدُودِ” (*as-haabul ukhdood*), “أَصْحَابُ الْأَيْكَةِ” (*as-haabul aikah*), and “أَصْحَابُ الْحَجَرِ” (*as-haabul hijr*). These have been used for different parties and groups. The details of which will be found in the relevant verses of the Quran.

“أَصْحَابُ الْكَهْفِ” (*as-haabul kahf*) and “أَصْحَابُ الرَّفِيعِ” (*as-haabur raqeeem*) have been mentioned in surah *Al-Kahaf*. For the detailed meanings of each see relevant headings.

Surah *At-Taubah* mentions the incident when the Messenger (*pbuh*) was in a cave and there was a companion with him (at the time of his migration from Mecca to Medina). Referring to this event the Quran quotes:

9:2	When the Messenger told his companion, “do not fear and grieve, Allah is with us”	إِذْ يَقُولُ لِصَاحِبِهِ لَا تَحْزَنْ إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَنَا
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History tells us that this companion was **Abu Bakar Siddique**. This is why other companions of the Messenger (*pbuh*) are called “صَاحِبِيَّ” (*sahaabah*) as well. This verse also points to another important issue of believing in the values of the Quran and then working for the establishment of the system with full conviction and commitment which puts individuals on a path of inner security and freedom from fear (24:55).

Sd-H-F ص ح ف

“الصَّحِيفُ” (*as-saheef*): the earth.

Ibn Faris says this root basically means very wide and has expanse.

“الصَّحَافُ” (*as-sihaaf*): small pools which are made to collect water.

“الصَّحْفَةُ” (*as-sohfah*): big goblet, a very broad cup from which five men can easily drink milk or water {T}.

“الصَّحِيفَةُ” (*as-saheefah*): the plurals are “الصَّحَافُ” (*as-saha'aif*) and “الصُّحُفُ” (*suhuf*) which means written paper. Generally it means cover or front page of a book {M}. It is used for every spread-out thing {R}.

“المُصْحَفُ” (*al mus-haaf*), “المُصْحَفُ” (*al mus-hif*), “المُصْحَفُ” (*al-mus-huf*) means a collection of different *sahifahs* (written pages) {R}.

“التَّصْحِيفُ” (*at-tasheef*): to recite the Quran. Because of doubtful words or letters, as they are not in the Quran, i.e. due to dubious words, recite the Quran wrongly.

The Quran has used “صِحَافٌ” (*sihaaf*) which has singular “صَحْفَةٌ” (*sahfah*) to mean big trays or cups (43:71). About the Messenger (*pbuh*) it is said:

98:2	Who recites (reads) puritan pages	يَتْلُوا صُحُفًا مُطَهَّرَةً
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In other words, it means to recite the Quranic verses, which are devoid of any human errors and unadulterated by human intellect, by calling the Quranic verses as “صُحُفٌ” (*suhuf*). It has been pointed out that these were being written down from the very beginning of the revelation.

It has been further elaborated in (80:13-15), i.e. “فِي صُحُفٍ مُّكَرَّمَةٍ” (*fi suhufin mukarramatin*) which means that it is written by the hands of the righteous, which put it down exactly as revealed.

This has been further explained by saying “بِأَيْدِي سَفَرَةٍ كَرَامٍ بَرَرَةٍ” (*bi-aidi safartatin kiram in bararazah*) which means that the Messenger (*pbuh*) had left complete Quran in written form for his followers. It is

not right to believe that the Quran was collected later by the Messenger's companions as referred in some of the historical books.

Aside from the Quran, the books of *Ibrahim* and *Moosa* have also been called “صُحُفِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ” (*suhufi Ibrahima*) and “صُحُفِ مُوسَى” (*suhufi Moosa*) in (87:19), and for commonly written things this word has been used in (81:10) and (74:52).

Sd-Kh-Kh ص خ خ

“الصَّخُّ” (*as-sakh*): to hit iron on iron, or to hit any hard object with another hard object {T, F}. The sound that is produced by hitting one hard thing with another is called “الصَّخَّةُ” (*as-sakh*) as well. “الصَّخَّةُ” (*as-sakh kha*) means a very harsh sound which deafens. It also means deep plight. “صَخَّيْتُ فَلَانٌ بَعْظِيمَةً” (*sakh khani fulanun bi-azeemah*): he leveled a very big allegation against me {T, F}.

For a great revolution, the Quran has declared:

80:33	the plight which renders one helpless	فَإِذَا جَاءَتِ الصَّخَّةُ
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If it has a connotation of battle, then it could also mean the sound of the weapons in battle. The modern industrial revolution can be termed as a form of “صَخَّةُ” (*as-sakhkha*).

Sd-Kh-R ص خ ر

“الصَّخْرَةُ” (*as-sakhr*): plural is “صَخْرٌ” (*sakhr*): very hard rock or a piece of a rock: “الصَّخْرُ” (*as-sakhr*): the sound which is produced by striking iron against iron {T, M, R}. It means the same as “صَخَّةُ” (*sakh-kha*). See heading (Sd-Kh-Kh).

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:63	When we took refuge behind the big stone (or rock)	إِذْ أَوْتَيْنَا إِلَى الصَّخَرَةِ
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Surah *Al-Fajr* quotes about the nation of *Samood*:

89:10	They carved big rocks to make their houses in the valley	جَانِبُوا الصَّخْرَ بِالْوَادِ
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Ibn Faris has said the same as *Kitaab-ul-Ashqaaq*, that “صَخْرَةٌ” (*sakharah*) does not mean every big stone but only big rock.

Sd-D-D ص د د

“صَدَّعَتْ” (*sadda unhu*), “يَصُدُّ” (*yasuddu*), “صُدُّوْا” (*sudooda*): to ignore or avoid someone/something {T, M}.

4:61	you will see that the hypocrites fully ignore you and turn away their faces	رَأَيْتَ الْمُنَافِقِينَ يَصُدُّونَ عَنْكَ صُدُّوْا
2:217	to prevent from (following) the way of Allah	وَصَدَّ عَنْ سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ
43:77	your nation cries out at it	إِذْ أَقْوَمَكَ مِنْهُ يَصُدُّونَ

“صَدَّعَتْ عَنْهُ” (*saf dahu unhu*), “يَصُدُّهُ” (*yusudduhu*), “صَدَّأً” (*sadda*): prevented him from something, removed him, turned him away, stopped him {T, M}.

“صَدَّ” (*sadda*), “يَصُدُّ” (*yasiddu*), “صَدِيدًا” (*sadeeda*): he raised a hue and cry, raised a din {T, M}.

“صَدِيدٌ” (*sadeed*) means boiling, hot water, or the bloody water that seeps out of a wound, or the water that will drip from the skins of the hell dwellers. It also means pus or similar discharge {T, M}. The water in hell has been called “مَاءٌ صَدِيدٌ” (*ma-inn sadeed*) in (14:16). Fields are always nurtured with cold water. Hot, boiling water withers the plants and stops their growth. As such, in a hellish society, people get to maintain their lives but they lives wither away. In verse (47:15) it has been called “مَاءٌ حَمِيمًا” (*ma-un*

hammeem). Stoppage or stultification of human personality's development is what hellish environment is. See heading (J-He-M).

Sd-D-R

ص د ر

“الصَّدْرُ” (**as-sadoor**) means chest. Plural is “صُدُورٌ” (**sudoor**). Later it started to mean the front or best or essential part of a thing.

“صَدْرُ الْقَوْمِ” (**sadar-ul-qoum**): the leader or head of a nation {T}.

“صَدَرَ” (**sadar**), “يَصْدُرُ” (**yasduru**): go back, return. It basically means for cattle etc. to return after watering. “وَرُودٌ” (**wurood**): to go to the drinking spot for drinking water.

“صُدُورٌ” (**sudur**): to come back.

“الصَّادِرُ” (**as-saadir**): someone who returns {T}. This word means to go beyond, to go forth and to return. It also means to come out, as it has appeared in (99:6).

“أَصْدَرَ” (**asdar**): to take back, to return something. It has meant to make the animals drink and then to bring them back in (28:23).

“صَدْرٌ” (**sadr**), plural of which is “صُدُورٌ” (**sudoor**) has been used in the meaning of heart in the Quran.

3:28	Whatever you conceal in your hearts	إِنْ تُخْفُوا مَا فِي صُدُورِكُمْ
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Raghib says that where “الْقَلْبُ” (**al-qalb**) has appeared, it means knowledge and intellect, and wherever the word “صَدْرٌ” (**sadr**) has been used, it includes emotions as well as knowledge and intellect, but it is not a rule.

The Quran has called itself “شِفَاءٌ لِّمَا فِي الصُّدُورِ” (**shifaa-ul lima fis sudoor**) in (10:57). It means that it is a treatment and cure for all psychological and mental problems. The Quran deals with the development of the human self which includes the use of emotions, meta cognition, memory, human body, etc. The Quran invites us to this aspect e.g. (59:19) and declares that each self by virtue of possessing a free will is accountable for its deeds in this life. It puts great emphasis on understanding the Quran through the use of human intellect and reasoning and thus understand the purpose of human creation. The acceptance of the Quranic permanent values and then functioning within these values leads to the development of an integrated self which frees one from the struggle of multiselves which create inner conflicts and are the source of many psychological problems. The Quran has made it possible for all of us to access the details of this Integrated Self which provides total freedom from the shackles of all other beliefs. For more details, see under the heading (N.F.S).

Muheet has said that “بَنَاتُ الصَّدْرِ” (**banaatus sudoor**) means worries.

For the explanation of “صَدْرٌ” (**sadr**) see heading (Sh-R-H).

Sd-D-Ain

ص د ع

Ibn Faris says it means for something to open up or to become slightly faulty, or to develop a crack in something.

“الصَّدْعُ” (**as-sad'u**) means to drill a hole or cause a split in a hard thing {T, R}.

“الصَّدْعُ” (**as-sid-u**): a group or party of people. It also means a piece of a thing, or half of a torn thing.

“صَدَعَهُ” (**sad'ah**), “صَدَّعَا” (**sad'a**): he tore it, turned it into two halves.

“الْمَصَادِعُ” (**al-masadi'u**) means soft paths on hard ground. It also means sharp point of an arrow.

“الصُّدَاعُ” (**as-sooda'a**): headache, the pain which feels as if splitting the head.

“تَصَدَّعَ الْقَوْمُ” (**tasadda ul qoum**) and “أَصْدَعُوْهُ” (**as-saddda'u**): the nation started differing.

“صُدَّعَ الرَّجُلُ” (**suddi-ar rujul**): he had a headache {T}.

Surah **Al-Hijr** tells the Messenger (**pbuh**):

15:94	ignore these hypocrites, and organize your own party	فَاصْدَعْ بِمَا تُؤْمَرُ وَاعْرِضْ عَنِ الْمُشْرِكِينَ
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First part of this verse is explaining the second.

Some say it means “whatever is told to you, relate it clearly to them”, but the former meaning seems more appropriate.

The Quran says:

30:43	the day they will separate	يَوْمَئِذٍ يَصْدَعُونَ
56:19	it will not cause a headache (there will be no mental problem)	لَا يُصْدَعُونَ عَنْهَا
59:21	that which will turn to pieces	خَا شِعَا مُتَصَدِّعًا
86:13	at the time when the plants grow, the ground splits	وَالْأَرْضِ ذَاتِ الصَّدْعِ

The Quran says that everything in the universe has been created to produce constructive results, but we find that some things are also destructive. This destruction is actually the basis of re-construction. For example we seed the earth, then the seed splits and along with it the earth splits too. Apparently this is a destructive act, but this way the crop begins growing, which is totally productive with positive result. This way every constructive act may first be destructive. “لَا إِلَهَ” (*la ilaha*) is necessary before “إِلَّا اللَّهُ” (*ill-Allah*), but if there is only “لَا” (*la*) in some program then it produces only destructive results. Therefore for the earth to be the embodiment of “ذَاتُ الصَّدْعِ” (*zatis-sad'i*) is necessary for human development.

Sd-D-F ص د ف

“الصَّدْفُ” (*as-sadaf*): sea shell, every tall building or wall or mountain {T}.

Ibn Faris says “الصَّدْفُ” (*as-sadaf*) means the side or corner of a mountain because it seems to lean to one side.

The Quran says “إِذَا سَاوَىٰ بَيْنَ الصَّدَفَيْنِ” (*saawa bainas sadafain*) in (18:96). Here “صَدَفَيْنِ” (*sadafain*) means two big mountains.

“الصَّدْفُ” (*as-sadaf*): the slackness in the legs of a camel or horse or bend {T}.

“صَدَفَ عَنْهُ” (*sadafa unhu*) means to ignore somebody, or avoid him {R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means leaning and predilection.

When “عَنْ” (*un*) is used with it then it will mean to turn the face away (6:158). Sometimes even without “عَنْ” (*un*) it has this meaning.

“صَدَفَ فُلَانٌ” (*sadafa fulanun*) means that he leaned, or turned his face away.

The Quran says:

6:46	These people turn their faces away and ignore even at this	ثُمَّ هُمْ يَصْدِفُونَ
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“الصَّدُوفُ” (*as-sadoof*): a woman who first shows her face, and then turns it away {T}.

“صِدْقٌ” (*sidq*) is the opposite of “كُذْبٌ” (*kizb*) which, as the heading (K-Dh-B) explains, is when what is in the mind is not being said, even if the spoken matter is in fact true. So “صِدْقٌ” (*sidq*) is used when what is in the mind is also being said even if the spoken matter is not a fact. Hence “صِدْقٌ” (*sidq*) means to tell the truth, as you believe and know it to be. Say a person knows about something which is wrong but he relates it truthfully and faithfully. In this case inner self is one as what is in his mind, he is declaring the same through his spoken word but what he is relating is not true. We will not call such a person a liar but what he is saying would be wrong.

“صِدْقٌ” (*sidq*) also means intensity and power {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means strength, because truth in itself is strong and a lie is inherently weak.

“شَيْءٌ صِدْقٌ” (*shai-un sidqun*) means a solid and hard thing.

“رُمْحٌ صِدْقٌ” (*rumhun sidq*) means a strong spear. As such, whatever words are related to this root would have the connotation of strength. This should be kept in mind.

“الصَّدِيقُ” (*as-sadeeq*): a friend.

“الصَّدِيقُ” (*as-siddiq*): a very truthful person, or a person who has never told a lie. It is used for a person so truthful that a lie is not even expected of him.

“صِدِّيقٌ” (*siddiq*) means one who is true in his sayings and belief and verifies it by his deeds.

“صَدَّقَ” (*saddaq*) means to prove true by deeds (details are ahead).

“الصَّدَقَةُ” (*as-sadaqah*) means anything which is given in the way of Allah {*T, M*}. Some think that “صَدَقَةُ” (*sadaqah*) is not binding but is given as philanthropy and that “زَكَاةٌ” (*zakah*) is binding, as it has been detailed under the heading (Z-K-W). When a Quranic system is implemented, whatever that is above the needs of people, goes towards the welfare of the society and humankind. But in the period before reaching this stage, an Islamic society fixes a sum on every individual, which is generally collected from the people. The ultimate of the system is as declared in the verse (2:219) i.e. keep open for the good of others, what is beyond one's need.

For this the word “زَكَاةٌ” (*zakah*) has been used, but in emergency situations individuals are appealed to donate. Hence whatever they can give at such a time is called “صَدَقَةٌ” (*sadaqah*). This too is collected collectively and disbursed collectively under the system (9:103, 9:60).

“صَدَقَ” (*sadaqah*) means that he proved whatever he said by his deeds.

The Quran says:

33:23	Momineen are those who prove what they promise Allah by their deeds.	مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ رِجَالٌ صَدَقُوا مَا عَاهَدُوا اللَّهَ عَلَيْهِ
3:150	Verily Allah practically proved his promise towards you to be true	وَلَقَدْ صَدَقَكُمُ اللَّهُ وَعْدَهُ
39:94	Praise to the Sustainer, who has proven the promise He made to us to be true	الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي صَدَقَنَا وَعْدَهُ

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says that the virtuous way is not that you face East or West (in worship) but to have the right concept about life and to prove it to be true with your deeds. People who commit such deeds are:

2:177	these are the people who have proven their trust through their deeds	أُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ صَدَقُوا
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Aside from proving by deeds as to the right concept of life, “صَدَقَ” (*saadiq*) is one who presents reasoning in support of his claims of way of life (2:111). Whatever is given to atone for not doing what is binding is also called “صَدَقَةٌ” (*sadaqah*) according to (2:196).

Surah **Al-Baqrah** has used the word “صَدَقَاتٌ” (*sadaqaat*) against “الرِّبَا” (*riba*) in (2:276).

“رِّبَا” (*riba*) means to take more than what is due to you, and “صَدَقَةٌ” (*sadaqah*) is to give more than what is binding on you, that is, for the welfare of others.

That is why it is said:

2:276	<i>riba</i> (which you proudly collect) leads to destruction, and <i>sadaqaat</i> increase greatly	يَمْحَقُ اللَّهُ الرِّبَا وَيُزِيلُ الصَّدَقَاتِ
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“تَصَدَّقَ” (*tasaddaqa*) and “أَصَدَّقَ” (*as-saddaq*) means whatever is due to you and binding, to let it go willingly, or to willingly part with it.

For example, if the borrower has become poor or unable to return the loan then to forego the loan (2:280, 5:54, 4:92). A bride’s wedding gift is also called “صَدَقَةٌ” (*sadaqah*) as in (4:4), but the Quran has used “صَدُوقٌ” (*saduqa*) for this. The wedding gift is not to be considered as a price for marrying a woman. It is simply a gift which is willingly and happily given by the husband as part of the marriage contract to his wife as an equal partner and it must be given.

“صَدُوقٌ” (*saduqa*) has the connotation of sincerity and friendship.
“صَدِيقٌ” (*sadeeq*) means friend (24:61). It is both singular and plural.

Surah *Yunus* says “We granted the Bani Israel with “مَبُوءَ صِدْقٍ” (*mabuwwa sidq*)” in (10: 93). It means a land which is full of strengths, potentialities and delights.

The Quran has used both “صَدَقَ” (*saddaq*) and “صَدَّقَ” (*sadaq*) to mean to prove true by deed.

The Quran says:

48:27	Verily Allah will make His Messenger’s dream come true	لَقَدْ صَدَّقَ اللَّهُ رَسُولَهُ الرُّءُوفَ بِالْحَقِّ
37:105	you (<i>Ibrahim</i>) made your dream come true	قَدْ صَدَّقْتَ الرُّءُوبَا

“صَدَّقَ” (*sadaq*) is also stated as investigation in (48:27) would therefore mean that Allah verified the dream of the Messenger and told him that it would be proven true.

“صَدَّقَ” (*saddaq*) leads to “مُصَدِّقٌ” (*musaddaq*) which means one who makes the dream come true (3:38).

Allah has repeatedly said that this Quran is “مُصَدِّقًا لِمَا مَعَكُمْ” (*musaddaqil lima ma-a-kum*), as in (2:41). This does not mean that the books with people (supposed to be celestial books) are true, because the Quran itself has said that these books have been altered and amended by human beings which have changed the original revelation. As such, how can it say that these books are true if they have been amended and changed?

“مُصَدِّقًا لِمَا مَعَكُمْ” (*musaddeqal lima ma’a-kum*) states a very big truth. Every nation of the world has a set of ordinary principles of moral conduct. For instance, every nation has the moral of not lying and speaking the truth, and not to commit theft, not to bother anybody etc. But these teachings are mere concepts. There is no practical system in which these are to be done. The Quran however, not only teaches such good principles but also gives a system in which these traits are actually practiced.

The whole world says that oppressors do not flourish long, but still we find oppressors flourishing. The Quran also says:

6:135	Indeed, He will not let the wrongdoers succeed.	إِنَّهُ لَا يُفْلِحُ الظَّالِمُونَ
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But along with this teaching it also gives a system in which this principle or precept comes out as the truth. This is what “مُصَدِّقًا لِمَا مَعَكُمْ” (*mussaddiqil lima ma’a-kum*) means, i.e. the principles which are merely concepts in other teachings, take practical shape in the Quran, and are thus proven true. Thus the Quran turns these principles, as well as other principles which the Quran contains and which have completed the Divine Guidance, into Truth. The pointers in previous books (Torah and the Bible) about the advent of Messenger *Muhammed (pbuh)* were proven true by his actual advent.

Allama Hamieeduddin Farahmi has written in his book “*Mufardaatul Quran*” that “مُصَدِّقَاتُ يَدَيْهِ” (*musaddi fallima baina yadaih*) are two sentences whose true meanings have escaped most. They thought that the Quran has verified the previous books (which have been changed).

“مُصَدِّقًا” (*musaddiq*) has two meanings. One is to verify what a man says, or to verify something. The other meaning is to make it true in his expectations. Consider the verse which says “may my life and everything be sacrificed on those brave men on whom all my expectations are proved right”

It has been said in the same connotation that:

34:20	And <i>Iblees</i> proved true his thoughts about them, and they followed him.	وَلَقَدْ صَدَّقَ عَلَيْهِمْ إِبْلِيسُ ظَنَّهُ فَاتَّبَعُوهُ
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If deliberated upon, one can find out that here the second meaning is right because the Quran and the Messenger (*pbuh*) made their appearance exactly as predicted in the Torah. As such, their advent proved the predictions true. So if they deny the Messenger (*pbuh*) and the Quran, then it would be a denial of prediction of their own Holy Book. We will leave this debate here and those who are interested in this debate can refer to pages 64-67 of the above mentioned book.

Aside from the above, the following forms of “صَدَقَ” (*sadaq*) have come to mean to tell the truth, or verify.

“صَدَقَ الْمُرْسَلُونَ” (*sadaqal mursaloono*) means to make something come true (36:52).

“وَأُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ صَدَقُوا” (*oolaikal lazeena sadaqu*) as in (2:177), and “لَقَدْ صَدَقَ اللَّهُ رَسُولَهُ الرُّءُيَا” (*sadaqal laahu rasulahur ruya*) in (48:27), as well as “قَدَّمَ صِدْقًا” (*qadama sidq*) in (10:2) means superiority which is for honor and respect.

“مُذْخَلٌ صِدْقًا” (*mudkhala sidqin*) and “مُخْرَجٌ صِدْقًا” (*mukhraja sidq*), as in (17:80), is to proceed with honor and to recede with honor at the right moment, or to enter some affair with veracity and exit it with veracity, or be absolved of the responsibility with veracity.

“لِسَانَ صِدْقٍ” (*lisaana sidq*): true fame, because of respect and honor (26:84).

“مَقْعِدٌ صِدْقٍ” (*maq-adis-sidq*): a point of stay where all of life’s pleasantries are present (54:55).

“صَادِقٌ” (*saadiq*): truthful, sincere.

“أَصْدَقُ” (*asdaq*): more truthful.

“تَصْدِيقٌ” (*tasdeeq*): to prove to be true by deeds (12:111).

“مُتَصَدِّقٌ” (*musiddiq*): someone who gives something as a gift or to forego that which is due to him (12:88).

Surah *Al-Hadeed* has called those who give “صدقه” (*sadaqah*) as “مُصَدِّقٌ” (*musaddiq*) in (57:18) i.e. whatever is due over and above that, all this so that they prove their claim that the purpose of their lives is to help self-develop others.

“صَدَقَ” (*saddaqa*) has been used against “كَذَّبَ” (*kazzab*) in (75:31-32).

The above shows that in any form, “صِدْقٌ” (*sidq*) has the connotation of willingness and homogeneity. That is, whatever is given and whatever is accepted is with a good heart, willingly and happily. It should have no element of coercion and use of force. It is the basic point that Quran makes, and that is, whatever a man does, must be done willingly and with a good heart. This element can be a source of strength not only for the doer but also for entire mankind. As such “صِدْقٌ” (*sidq*) holds a great importance.

“الْصَّدَى” (*as-sada*) has a lot of meanings one of which is an echo.
 “أَصْدَى الْجَبَلِ” (*asdal jabal*): the mountain replied to the echo.
 “الْصَّدَا” (*as-sadaa*): complete or final voice.
 “التَّصْدِيَةُ” (*at-tasdiyah*): to clap {T}

Raghib says “التَّصْدِيَةُ” (*at-tasdiyah*) means any sound which is not tuneful or modulated.

The Quran says that with the Arabs of the early period, *salaat* was nothing but “مُكَاءٌ وَتَصْدِيَةٌ” (*mukaun wa tasdiyah*) (8:35), i.e. meaningless sounds and movement {R}. For details see heading (M-K-W).

“صَادَاةً” (*saadah*): to come in front, to appear before.
 “تَصَدَّى لَهُ” (*tasadda lahu*): to appear before someone with head raised high, or to come before somebody repeatedly. Therefore, it means to return to someone repeatedly like an echo, or to pay attention {M}.

80:6	you attend to it very eagerly	فَأَنْتَ لَهُ تَصَدَّى
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Ibn Faris says it means for something to become open or become evident.

“الصَّرْحُ” (*as-sarah*): the purity in anything. Some say it means something which is pure and white.
 “كَأْسٌ صُرَاحٌ” (*kaasun surah*): the cup (goblet) which has no adulteration and is pure.
 “التَّصْرِيعُ” (*at-tasreeh*): make smooth, or to settle a matter, or for a matter to be clean and pure {T, R}.
 “لَبَنٌ صَرِيحٌ” (*labanun sareeh*): pure milk in which the foam has settled down.
 “الصَّرَاحِيَّةُ” (*as-suraahiyah*): pure wine.
 “الصَّرَاحِيَّةُ” (*as-surahiyah*): goblet for wine.
 “الصَّرْحَةُ” (*as-sarha*): the top soil or the upper part of the earth, smooth land.
 “الصَّرْحُ” (*as-sarh*): high, engraved, and decorated house which stands out from the others, high building.
 Later it began to be used for a palace {T, R}.

Surah *An-Namal* says:

27:44	Indeed it is a place made smooth as glass	إِنَّهُ صَرَحٌ مُّزَكَّى مِنْ قَوَارِيرَ
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Here it means palace.

Surah *Al-Momin* has used “صَرْحًا” (*sarhan*) in (40:36) to mean a tall building.

“الصَّرَاخُ” (*as-suraakh*): harsh voice or pleading.
 “الصَّرْحَةُ” (*as-sarkhah*): to cry out loud at the time of difficulty or pleading.
 “الصَّارِكُ” (*as-saarikh*): someone who pleads. It also means one who reaches to help the pleader.
 “الصَّرِيحُ” (*as-sareekh*) also has the same meaning {T, M}.

The Quran says:

36:43	they will have no one to listen to their pleadings (no savior)	فَلَا صَرِيحٌ لَهُمْ
14:22	I cannot plead for you	مَا أَنَا بِمُصْرِخِكُمْ
35:37	they will call out for help in it (plead, implore, beg for help)	وَهُمْ يَصْطَرِّحُونَ فِيهَا

“صَرِيحٌ” (*sareekh*) also is a noun and also means pleading and cries.

“الْمُصْرِخُ” (*al-musrikh*): one who reaches to help on the pleadings (savior), one who reaches for help.
 “اِصْطَرَّخَ” (*istarakh*): to cry out, shout (in anguish).
 “اِسْتَصْرَخَ” (*istasrakh*): to ask someone for help, to cry out for help (28:18).

Sd-R-R

ص ر ر

“الصَّرَّةُ” (*as-sirrah*), “الصَّرُّ” (*as-sirru*): cold or the intensity of cold {T}. It also means the cold (frost) which destroys crops {L}.

Zajaaj says that “الصَّرَّةُ” (*as-sirrah*) means fervent cries for help.

“رِيحٌ صِرٌّ” (*reeun sirruw*) and “صَرَصَرٌ” (*sar-sar*) means fast wind with a harsh sound.

Ibn Abbas says it also means very hot wind {T}, but “صَرٌّ” (*sarr*) basically means to bind.

Raghib says the word “صَرٌّ” (*sar*) has also come from “صَرَّ صَرٌّ” (*sar sar*), because cold freezes things as well, that is, binds them closely.

“إِصْرَارٌ” (*israar*) means to be resolute on something.

“الصَّرَّةُ” (*as-surrah*) means money bag {T} and the money so bound in the bag is called as “الصَّرِيرَةُ” (*sareerah*) {T}

Ibn Faris says this word also means to be high and lofty.

“الصَّرَارُ” (*as-siraar*) are the high houses which are out of reach of flood waters.

To mean intense cold, this word has been used by the Quran in (3:116). Verse (54:19) uses “رِيحًا صَرَّارًا” (*reehun sar sar*)

Surah *Az-Zaariyaat* says “فِي صَرَّةٍ” (*fi sarrah*). It also means to make faces {T} and also means the intensity of crying out and pain {T}. It also means intensity of anything i.e. of wonderment or surprise.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says “وَلَمْ يُصِرُّوا” (*walam yusirru*) in (3:135), which means that they do not insist, are not dogmatic on realizing their mistake. After realizing their mistake they give it up and do not go in this direction.

Sd-R-T

ص ر ط

“صِرَاطٌ” (*siraat*) is often read as “سِرَاطٌ” (*siraat*) and means to swallow something without chewing.

“صِرَاطٌ” (*siraat*) means a long sword which cuts anything it falls on. In other words, it swallows anything.

“صِرَاطٌ” (*siraat*) means open and clear path, either the traveler keeps swallowing it (traversing it) or it swallows thousands of travelers {T}.

The Quran says “الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ” (*as-sirratim mustaqeem*) in (1:5). At another place it is called “طَرِيقٌ” (*tareeq*) “مُسْتَقِيمٌ” (*mustaqeem*) in (46:30). “صِرَاطٌ” (*siraat*) therefore means the same as “طَرِيقٌ” (*tareeq*) which means path or way.

For the meaning of “مُسْتَقِيمٌ” (*mustaqeem*), see heading (Q-W-M).

There is no mention of *pul-e-siraat* (bridge of *siraat*) in the Quran.

“الصَّرْعُ” (*as-sar’u*), “الصَّرْعُ” (*as-sir’u*): to dash on the ground, to spread-eagle.
 “الصَّرْعَةُ” (*as-sura’ah*): the man who spread-eagles a lot of people.
 “الصَّرِيعُ” (*as-saree’u*): one who is spread-eagled (defeated). The plural is “صَرَاعِي” (*sar’ah*) {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

69:7	you will find them spread-eagled in it	فَتَرَى الْقَوْمَ فِيهَا صَرْعَى
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“الصَّرْعُ” (*as-sar’u*) means epilepsy.
 “الصَّرْعُ” (*as-sar’u*), “الصَّرْعُ” (*as-sir’u*): like, similar.
 “بُصَايِرَ عَانٍ” (*huma siraa’aan*): they are equal and similar to one another.
 “الْمِصْرَاعَانِ مِنَ الْبَابِ” (*al-misraani minal baab*): both parts of the door.
 “الْمِصْرَاعَانِ مِنَ الشَّعْرِ” (*almisra-aani minash sher*): both verses of the couplet {*T, M, R*}.

“الصَّرْفُ” (*as-sarf*) means to turn the state of a thing from one to another, or to change it with something else. That is, either to effect a change in the state or condition of a thing, or to change it with some other thing {*R*}. It means to return, to change the direction, to remove {*T*}.
 “صَرَفَ الصِّبْيَانَ مِنَ الْمَكْتَبِ” (*sarafas sibyaana minal maktab*): returned children from school.
 “صَرَفَ الرَّسُولَ” (*sarafar rasul*): returning a messenger from where he came {*T*}.
 “تَصَارِيفُ الْأُمُورِ” (*tasareeful umoor*): the juxtaposition of affairs and to put them in place of another.
 “الْمَصْرِفُ” (*al-masrif*): the place where to return, the place from where to move away.
 “تَصْرِيفُ الرِّيَّاحِ” (*tasreefur riyah*): to turn the winds from one direction to another.
 “انْصَرَفَ” (*inn sarafa*): stopped, returned.
 “صَرَفَ الْخَمْرَ” (*saraful khamr*) and “تَصْرِيفُ الْخَمْرِ” (*tasreefal khamr*): to drink alcohol without mixing anything (neat).
 “الصَّرِيفُ” (*as-sareef*): pure silver.
 “الصَّرَافُ” (*as-sarraf*), “الصَّيْرَفِيُّ” (*as-sairaafi*): someone who judges coins, or the exchanger of coins.

The Quran says “تَصْرِيفُ الرِّيَّاحِ” (*tasreefir riyah*) in (2:164), i.e. to make the winds blow in various directions, or to change their state.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

18:54	And We have certainly explained it in the Quran by using various ways	وَلَقَدْ صَرَّفْنَا فِي هَذَا الْقُرْآنِ
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Also see (17:89) and (17:41).

The Quran relates the laws and the truths in many different ways:

17:41	so that people can understand them well (So that all angles are understood by people)	لِيَذْكُرُوا
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This technique has been adopted by the Quran to make its meanings clear. That is, to bring or relate a thing repeatedly, but in different ways so that all angles and aspects are elaborated and well comprehended. This is what appears as a repetition to some. The Quran recognizes the significance of human emotions and thought processes in association with human memory. Since the Quran emphasizes on the use of human intellect and reasoning, therefore in the process of reflecting on the human conduct and behavior it refers to these issues to answer the questions likely to arise in a probing and questioning mind. This is the reason that the Quran says that there are great signs within it for those who are seeking answers to their questions e.g. (12:7, 101, 25:33).

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says that those whom you follow will deny that they asked you to follow them:

25:19	you will not have the power to refute them, or to turn away our punishment, or remove yourselves from this position	فَمَا تَسْتَطِيعُونَ صَرْفًا
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Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:53	there will be no place where they can take refuge from the consequences (punishment)	وَلَمْ يَجِدُوا عَنْهَا مَصْرِفًا
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Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:34	So Allah turned or removed the women's intrigues from him (protected him from their conspiracies)	فَصَرَفَ عَنْهُ كَيْدَهُنَّ
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Surah *Al-Ahqaaf* says:

46:29	we turned their direction towards you	إِذْ صَرَفْنَا إِلَيْكَ---
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These two verses explain the meaning of “صَرَفَ عَنْ” (*sarafa'un*) and “صَرَفَ إِلَى” (*sarafa'ila*).

Surah *Hoodh* says about punishment:

11:8	nothing will turn it away from them	لَيْسَ مَصْرُوفًا عَنْهُمْ
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Surah *At-Taubah* says:

9:127	to turn away	إِنْصَرَفَ
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“صَرَفَ” (*sarafa*): to turn away from somebody.

Sd-R-M ص ر م

“صَرَمَ” (*saram*), “يَصْرِمُ” (*yasrim*): he cut the rope or the bunch of fruits and removed it.

“صَرَمَ النَّخْلَ” (*sarafal nakhl*): he cut the date fruits.

“صَرَمَ الْحَبْلَ” (*saramal habl*): the rope broke.

“أَصْرَمَ النَّخْلَ” (*asramal nakhl*): the time for cutting the date fruits has arrived.

“الصَّرِيمَةُ” (*as-sareemah*): the field whose crop has been cut away.

“الصَّرِيمُ” (*as-sareem*): cut, detached. It also means barren land in which nothing grows.

Day and night are also called “صَرِيمٌ” (*sareem*) because one cuts off another.

“الصَّارِمُ” (*as-saarim*): the one which cuts. It also means lion.

“إِنْصِرَامٌ” (*insiraam*): to be cut off {T}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is to cut or detach.

The Quran says they swore to:

68:17	they will cut the crop as soon as it was morning	لَيَصْرِمُنَّهَا مُصْبِحِينَ
68:22	those who cut the crop (get what they deserve)	فَأَصْبَحَتْ كَالصَّرِيمِ

A couple of verses back it is said that the garden became fallow as if its fruits had been picked (68:20).

This in surah *Al-Ambia* has been likened to “حَصِيدًا” (*haseeda*) (21:15). Usually crop is said to be “حصاد” (*hisaad*) and garden is “صرم” (*sareem*).

“الصَّرِيمُ” (*as-sareem*) also means night as it is dark {T}. Hence it is the symbol of bad luck. If in the above verses (68:20), this meaning is taken, then it would mean that the garden burnt black just like darkness of the night.

See heading (S-T-R).

“صَعِدَ فِي السُّلَّمِ أَوْ الْجَبَلِ وَصَعَدَ عَلَيْهِ وَفِيهِ” (*saa-ida fis sullami awil jabal wa sa'ada alaihi wafih*): he climbed a ladder or a mountain etc. It is also used for going away.
 “أَصْعَدَ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*as'ada fil ard*): he roamed till afar {T, M}.

The Quran says:

3:152	when you were going afar	إِذْ تُصْعِدُونَ
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“الصَّعِيدُ” (*as-saeed*) means land or earth (18:40, 4:43). It also means dust, or storm, as well as the upper part of the earth. Since going up or climbing makes one breathless, therefore “صَعُودٌ” (*sa-ood*) means a difficult task because it too makes one ‘breathless’.

“تَصَعَّدَ نَبِيٌّ ذَلِكَ الشَّيْءُ” (*tas adda fi zaalikash shaiyi*): this thing has become very difficult for me {T, M}.
 “صَعْدٌ” (*sa-adun*): intense, hard {T, M}

Ibn Faris says it basically means height and hard work.

Surah *Al-Jinn* say:

72:17	gives him severe punishment	يَسْلُكُهُ عَذَابًا صَعَدًا
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Surah *An-Anaas* says that Islam is accepted through the broadening of vision (widening of the chest or heart).. When someone thinks of Islam who has narrow vision and narrow minded they are like:

6:126	as if they are climbing with great difficulty (climbing a height which has an undefined end)	كَأَنَّمَا يَصْعَدُ فِي السَّمَاءِ
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Surah *Al-Faatir* says:

35:10	a pleasant concept of life	إِلَيْهِ يَصْعَدُ الْكَلِمُ الطَّيِّبُ
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It is said that one attains great height gradually according to Allah's scales, but this rise is slow when compared to the human scales. *Ibn Faris* too says this is the basic meaning.

35:10	Good deed ascend it	وَالْعَمَلُ الصَّالِحُ يَرْفَعُهُ
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The concept of life, as ordained by Allah, has the ability to rise high, and in normal circumstances these keep rising according to the scaling defined by Allah. If human righteous deeds join hands in these natural scales then the results accelerate and these effects are visible within a short span of time. For example if the Quranic values are followed the poverty can be eliminated within a short span of time.

This aspect is mentioned in:

32:5	In the end all affairs rise up to Him	ثُمَّ يَرْجِعُهُ إِلَيْهِ
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“الصَّعْرُ” (*as-sa’ar*) is a sort of sickness among camels in which the neck turns to one side and the face becomes distorted. It also means pride and arrogance.

“صَعِرَ” (*sa’era*), “يَصْعَرُ” (*yas’ar*), “صَعْرًا” (*sa’ara*): the face to be distorted, or turn to one side.

“الصَّعَارُ” (*as-sa’aar*): means pride and vanity, because a proud man sort of turns his neck and lowers his cheek and turns away his face from people (as if in loathing) {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to bend and become crooked.

The Quran says:

31:18	do not avoid people due to pride (do not be averse to people)	لَا تُصْعِرْ خَدَّكَ لِلنَّاسِ
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Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is of a harsh sound.

“صَاعِقَةٌ” (*sa’iqah*): the sound of thunder {*T, M*}. The plural is “صَوَائِقُ” (*swa’iq*).

“جَمَارٌ صَعِقٌ” (*himarun sa’iq*): a donkey which brays very harshly.

“صَعِقَ” (*sa’iq*): fall unconscious and to lose sense and intellect {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says about *Bani Israel*:

2:55	to fall unconscious	فَأَخَذَتْكُمُ الصَّاعِقَةُ
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Also see heading (B-Ain-T) and (M-W-T).

“صَغَبَتِ الرَّكِيَّةُ” (*sa’iqatir rakiy yah*): it is said when the well collapses and mud begins to fall in from all sides {*T, M*}.

Every deadly punishment as death is also called “صَاعِقَةٌ” (*saa’iqah*) {*T, M*}.

To mean thunder as used in (2:19). To mean annihilation, it has been used in surah *At-Toor* where it is said:

52:44	So leave them alone until they encounter that day wherein they shall swoon (in terror)	فَذَرُهُمْ حَتَّى يُلَاقُوا يَوْمَهُمُ الَّذِي فِيهِ يُصْعَقُونَ
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In surah *Az-Zumr* where “نفخ صور” (*nufikha soor*) is mentioned, it is said:

39:68	lose sense and intellect	فَصَبَقَ مَنْ فِي السَّمُوتِ وَمَنْ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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For the meaning of “نفخ صور” (*nufikha soor*), see heading (N-F-Kh) and (Sd-W-R).

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:143	and <i>Moosa</i> fell unconscious	وَحَزَمُوسَى صَعِقًا
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“الصَّغَرُ” (*as-sighar*), “الصَّغَارَةُ” (*as-sagharah*): it is the opposite of “كِبَرٌ” (*kibr*) and “عَظَمٌ” (*izam*) which means big or great. Hence it means to be small, either in age or stature or physique {T}.
 “أَصْغَارُ” (*as-sagharu*): ignominy and infamy, subjugation {T}.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:13	Get out, you will never have greatness	فَاخْرِجْ إِنَّكَ مِنَ الصَّاغِرِينَ
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Greatness and success is achieved if efforts and deeds are according to the values of the Quran. Going against these values ultimately leads to to ignominy and defeat in life.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says about the criminals:

6:125	They will have to submit to Allah’s laws (eventually)	صَّغَارُ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ
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It means that they will be forced to follow the laws of the Islamic System established under the Quranic injunctions. This submission of criminals will be forced and they will have to accept it. Also see (7:119) and (27:37). It is obvious from the above explanations that “صَاغِرُونَ” (*saaghiroon*) means to stop being rebellious and to live as peaceful citizens and subjects of a state. This meaning is also gleaned from surah *At-Taubah* where it is said that those who have been granted the Book and are against the system, a fight may be required to force them to submit to the laws of the system. {T}.

It is evident from various verses in the Quran that it allows you to go to war against those who rebel against Allah’s laws and wage war against the Islamic system. Quran’s purpose for war is to subjugate the rebellious and the oppressors. It says that:

9:29	Till they agree to live like peaceful subjects of an Islamic state after paying taxes	حَتَّى يُعْطُوا الْجِزْيَةَ عَنْ يَدٍ وَهُمْ صَاغِرُونَ
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It means that until they agree to live peacefully, they would have to live like subjects in an Islamic state. But this will only be politically. Otherwise they will enjoy all human rights which are granted to every human individual. However, they cannot interfere in the government of an Islamic state.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:282	little or much	صَغِيرًا أَوْ كَبِيرًا
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“أَصْغَرُ” (*asghar*): to be smaller (10:61).

“صَغَا” (*sagha*), “يَصْغُو” (*yasghu*) and “صَغَى” (*saghy*), “يَصْغِي” (*yasgha*) means to be attracted, or to lean.
 “صَغَتِ الشَّمْسُ” (*safatis shams*): the sun leaned towards setting or sunset.
 “صَاغِيَةُ الرَّجُلِ” (*saaghiyatur rajul*): the man’s supporters.
 “صِغْوُهُ مَعَكَ” (*sighwu ma’aka*): his leaning is towards you.
 “أَصْغَى حَقَّهُ” (*asgha haqqah*): he reduced his right {T}.

The Quran says:

6:114	So that their hearts keep leaning towards it	وَلِتَصْغَى إِلَيْهِ أَفْئِدُهُ
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Also see (66:4).

- “الصَّفْحُ” (*as-safh*): the wider part of anything, side or direction.
 “الصَّفْحُ مِنَ السَّيْفِ” (*as-safhu minas saif*): the width of the sword, i.e. not the sharp side but the wide part.
 “المُسَفِّحُ” (*al-musaffah*): wide or broad thing.
 “الصَّفْحَةُ” (*as-safhah*): the surface of paper because of its breadth.
 “المُصَافَاةُ” (*al-musaafaha*): to shake hand {T, M, R}

Ibn Faris says the root means width.

“صَفَحَ” (*safah*): present one’s profile (by turning away the face). That is, to avoid something or ignore it.
 “صَفَحَ عَنْهُ” (*safdah unhu*): let him go, pardoned him. This is broader in meaning than “عَفُوَّ” (*afu*) because “عَفُوَّ” (*afu*) means to pardon after declaring a person a criminal, but in “صَفَحَ” (*safh*), he is not declared criminal at all {T, M, R}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* uses both these words together in (2:109).

Surah *Az-Zakhruf* says:

43:5	Do you think that We will ignore you and turn these historic truths away from you?	أَفَنَضْرِبُ عَنْكُمْ الذِّكْرَ صَفْحًا
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Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

15:85	Part with them very nicely (and form your own team)	فَاَصْنَحِ الصَّفْحَ الْجَمِيلَ
73:10	Be nice even if you have to part with someone	وَاهْجُرْهُمْ هَجْرًا جَمِيلًا

The Quran says that to be nice even if you have to part with someone, to part very nicely, in a good manner. It is important to reflect here on the Quranic guidance which is instructing to the believers to part with those who do not agree with the permanent values in a way which is pleasant, courteous, and well mannered. This is part of the training to bring inner change which the Quranic values inculcate within an individual which develop human self to ever increasing standard of righteousness – the upper limit of which is unknown. The Quran never closes the option of coming back to its guidance for anyone as it explains the importance of human creation due to the possession of free will and this life being the only opportunity for each one of us to choose to work for the next life.

“صَفَدَ” (*safad*), “صِفَادٌ” (*sifaad*) means leather strap or iron chain with which a prisoner is bound. It means bond, imprisonment or collar which was made of leather in those days. The plural is “أَصْفَادٌ” (*isfaad*).

“صَفَدَهُ” (*safadah*), “يَصْفِدُهُ” (*yasfedahu*) means to secure somebody with chains, etc.
 “الْصَفْدُ” (*as-safad*) also means such a gift which makes someone obliged and grateful. {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to bind and to gift.

The Quran says about the criminals:

14:49	they will be bound together with chains	مُفْرَرِينَ فِي الْأَصْفَادِ
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“الْصُّفْرَةُ” (*as-sufrah*): yellowness, or the state of being yellow.
 “الْصُّفْرَاءُ” (*as-safra*) means gold {T}. It is the feminine of “الْصُّفْرُ” (*asfar*). In this case, it would mean “of yellow color (for female)”.
 “الْصُّفْرُ” (*as-sifr*) means something which is empty or hollow {T}.
 “صَفَرَ إِنَاؤُهُ” (*safaira anawu*): his vessel became empty. Proverbially it means “his cattle died” {F}.
 “الصَّافِرُ” (*as-saafir*): a bird which can make different sounds.
 “الصَّافِرُ” (*as-safar*): the call one makes to cattle so it may come towards the Sheppard for a drink {T, M, R}. Hence it may as well mean the sound of a whistle.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* mentions that the bull of *Bani-Israel* was “صفراء” (*safra*), that it was of golden color (2:69). Surah *Al-Mursalaat* has compared the blaze of Jahannam with golden camels by calling then “جَمَلَاتُ صُفْرٍ” (*jimaalatun sufur*). Some say that “جَمَلَاتُ صُفْرٍ” (*jimaalatun sufur*) actually means black or dark colored camels. Since darkness of a camel color does not come without a shade of yellow, this word has been used in (77:33).

Surah *Az-Zumr* has used “مُصْفَرًّا” (*musfarra*) for yellow in (39:21).

Ibn Faris says it has five basic meanings but the Quran has used it for the above meanings only.

“الْصَّفُّ” (*as-saff*), “النَّصْفِيُّ” (*al-tasfeef*): to form rows, or for things to get in a row.
 “الْصَّفُّ” (*as-saff*): those who form a row {T, R}.

Raghib says it means to make men or trees stand in a row.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:48	they will be presented before your Lord in rows	وَأُغْرِضُوا عَلَىٰ رَبِّكَ صَفًّا
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“الْصَّفُّ” (*as-saff*): for birds to spread their wings in the air and not to move them (surf in the air).
 “صَافَاتٌ” (*saffaat*): with wings or arms spread {T, R}.

Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:41	birds with wings spread in the air	وَالطَّيْرُ صَفَّتْ
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Singular form is “صَافَاتٌ” (*saffah*).

“الْصَّافَّاتُ” (*as-safffaat*): groups or parties in rows (37:1).

“صَوَافٍ” (*sawwaaf*), “صَوَافٍ” (*swafif*): camels standing in a row (22:36).

This too is the plural of “صَافَةٌ” (*saffah*).

“مُصْفُوفَةٌ” (*musfoofah*): plants in a row (52:20).

“الْصَّفْصَفُ” (*as-saf-saf*): smooth and plain land from which grass and all plantations have been removed.

The Quran says:

20:106	plain or level ground	قَاعًا صَفْصَفًا
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“صَفَّةُ الدَّارِ” (*saffatud daar*): verandah of a house {T}.

“الصَّفْنُ” (*as-safn*): to join two things together so that some parts of one amalgamate with that of an other {R}.

“صَفَنَ الرَّجُلُ” (*safanar rajl*): a man placed both his feet in a row {M}.

“صَفَنَ الْفَرَسُ يَصْفُنُ” (*safanal farsu yas fin*), “صُفُونَا” (*sufuna*): a horse with one leg rose in such a way that its hoof keeps touching the ground barely {T}.

A horse standing in this way is called “صَافِنٌ” (*saafin*). Plurals are “صَوَافِينُ” (*sawafeen*) and “صَافِنَاتٌ” (*saafinaat*). Such horses were deemed of high quality among the Arabs.

The Quran says:

38:31	has been used for such pedigree horses	الصُّفُنُ الْجَيَادُ
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“الصَّفْوُ” (*as-safuo*), “الصَّفَاءُ” (*as-safaa*): the pure or clean part of something.

Raghib says its basic meaning is for something to be free of adulteration and be pure.

Ibn Faris too says that this is its basic meaning.

“صَفْوَةُ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*safwatu kulli shaiyi*): the pure part of everything.

“يَوْمٌ صَافٍ وَصَفْوَانٌ” (*yaumun saafin wa safwaan*): the cool day which is cloudless and the atmosphere is clean too.

“اصْطَفَاءُ” (*astifaa*): to choose or select clean and pure things.

“اسْتَصَفَاهُ” (*istasfah*): considered him to be sincere, selected him.

“الصَّفِيَّةُ” (*as-safiyyah*) with its plural form “صَفَايَا” (*safaya*) means that part of the booty which the leader selects for himself {T, M}.

“الصَّفَاةُ” (*as-afaah*) with its plural form “صَفَوَاتٌ” (*safawaat*) and “صَفَاً” (*safa*) means a very clean and smooth stone on which nothing can grow.

“الصَّفْوَانَةُ” (*as-safwanah*) plural of which is “صَفْوَانٌ” (*safwaan*) also means the same {T}, as used in (2:264). Some think that this is a collective noun. It could be that “الصَّفْوَانُ” (*safwaan*) means big rock and a piece of this rock is called “صَفْوَانَةٌ” (*safwanah*).

The Quran says:

2:130	We freed him of worldly attractions , and selected him for a great purpose	وَلَقَدْ اصْطَفَيْنَاهُ فِي الدُّنْيَا
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About various messengers, the Quran has said:

38:47	Indeed, they are among the chosen ones by Us	وَإِنَّهُمْ عِنْدَ نَالِمِنَ الْمُصْطَفَيْنَ الْأَخْيَارِ
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Surah *Bani Israel* says “اصْفَاكُمْ” (*as faakum*) in (17:40) which means “to select”, “separate from others and to give preference and stature”.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:158	Indeed, the <i>Saffa</i> and the <i>Marwa</i> are among symbols of Allah.	إِنَّ الصَّفَا وَالْمَرْوَةَ كُورٌ مِّنْ شَعَائِرِ اللَّهِ
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Saffa and *Marwa* are two hills near Mecca.

Surah *Muhammed* says:

47:15	purified honey	عَسَلٍ مُّصَفٍّ
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“صَكَّ” (*sak*): to hit, especially with a broad based thing.
 “صَكَّ الْبَابَ” (*sakkal baab*): he closed the door.
 “صَكَّهُ” (*sakkahu*), “صَكَّاهُ” (*sakka*): he pushed him {*T, M*}.

The Quran says about the wife of *Ibrahim*:

51:29	she struck her face with her hand (in disbelief)	فَصَكَّتْ وَجْهَهَا
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But this was only as an expression in amazement as she was not expecting to have a child in her late age as noted in (11:72).

“الصُّلْبُ” (*as-sulb*), “الصَّلِيبُ” (*as-saleeb*): strong and hard.
 “بُوِيَ صُلْبٌ فِي دِينِهِ” (*buwa sulbun fi deenih*): He is firm in his way of life.
 “صَلَّبَ” (*sallab*): he made it or him strong and hard.
 “الصُّلْبُ” (*as-sulb*): backbone {*T, M*}. Plural is “أَصْلَابُ” (*aslaab*).

Ibn Faris says the back is also called “الصُّلْبُ” (*as-sulb*) because of its sturdiness and strength.

The Quran says:

4:23	Your sons who are from your back (own womb)	أَبْنَائِكُمُ الَّذِينَ مِنْ أَصْلَابِكُمُ
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“الصَّلْبُ” (*as-salb*): to crucify a man to death.

Raghib says it is used for crucifixion because in crucifixion a man's back is tied to a strong wooden beam.

Some say that “الصَّلْبُ” (*as-saleeb*) means the little water that comes out of a dead man's mouth or nose. It also signifies the fat which is extracted from bones.

Ibn Faris has said that a man who is crucified is called “مَصْلُوبٌ” (*masloob*), because his face becomes greasy. Later the cross used for crucifixion came to be known as “صَلِيبٌ” (*saleeb*).

Raghib's argument seems stronger, because as the Christians say, a cross is in the shape of a plus sign and a man is crucified till he dies.

The Jews considered crucifixion as the worst form of death. They considered it to be a damned death. They claimed that by crucifying Jesus, they had given him an ignominious death.

The Christians do not believe that it is a damned death to die on the cross, but they do believe that Jesus was crucified. The Quran refutes both the Jewish and the Christian beliefs and says that this tale which they believe is totally wrong.

4:157	They did not kill him, neither did they crucify him. The truth became dubious for them	وَمَا قَتَلُوهُ وَمَا صَلَبُوهُ وَلَكِنْ شُبِّهَ لَهُمْ
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Isa (Jesus) had already left the place and some other man they had arrested thinking him to be *Isa*, was crucified instead. Details can be found in the book titled *Shola-e-Mastoor*.

The Quran has outlined different punishments for mutiny against an Islamic state and for creating chaos in society apropos the crime. One of them is “يُصَلَّبُونَ” (*yusallabu*) in (5:33). That is, to crucify or hang.
 “صَلَّبَ” (*sallab*) means to hang a man, and “صَلَّبَ” (*sallab*) means to hang more than one.

“أَصْلَحَ إِلَيْهِ” (*as laha ilaih*) means the same as “أَحْسَنَ إِلَيْهِ” (*ahsana ilaih*). It means that he did such a thing which removed the ills of the other. Hence it means to create a good balance.

“الصُّلْحُ” (*as sulh*) means mutual co-operation and peace because as compared to the times of war, in times of peace, there is more harmonious balance {T}.

“الصَّلَاحُ” (*as-salaah*) means for the situation to be harmonious with intellect and goodwill {T}. The state in which things should be organized for the establishment of peace, balance, harmony and order {L}.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* has used “صَالِحًا” (*swaleha*) to mean a perfectly healthy child (7:190). Here it means a child which is perfect in every way.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says with regards to a son being born to *Zikriyah* in old age:

21:90	We removed the fault from his wife which was a bar to conceiving a child	وَأَصْلَحْنَاهُ زَوْجَهُ
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Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:32	And the righteous ones among your male and female slaves	وَالصَّالِحِينَ مِنْ عِبَادِكُمْ وَ إِمَائِكُمْ
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Here it is used for slaves and slave girls who have the potentials and means to get married.

Surah *Yusuf* says that *Yusuf's* brothers discussed among themselves that their father's entire attention is towards Yusuf and his brother. If *Yusuf* is murdered or exiled, then this imbalance can be removed.

12:9	later after carrying out our plan we will become part of righteous (removing imbalance)	وَأَكُونُوا مِنْ بَعْدِهِ قَوْمًا صَالِحِينَ
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Here the word “صَالِحِينَ” (*saleheen*) makes clear that it means for imbalance or inequities to be removed, or for matters to come to an even keel.

The word “سَيِّئَاتٍ” (*sayyiaat*) has often been used by the Quran against “حَسَنَاتٍ” (*hasanaat*), as in (2:81-82). As against “سَيِّئَةٍ” (*sayyiatah*), “عَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ” (*aamilus salihaat*) has been used. Therefore good deeds and “عَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ” (*aamali salehaat*) mean the same.

So at all other places, as against “مَنْ عَمِلَ صَالِحًا” (*mun amela swalehan*), “مَنْ أَسَاءَ” (*mun asa'a*) has been used, as in (41:46). Under the headings (S-W-A) and (H-S-N) the meanings of these words will become clear. Therefore “عَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ” (*aamali salehaat*) means deeds which develop man's latent abilities and make them capable of evolving to the higher stages of life. Also, due to which the balance in the society is not disturbed and all disharmony is done away with. Such deeds bring the pleasantness of life with them. Hence it means to act according to the needs of the times and be harmonious with the permanent values of the Quran.

“فَسَادٌ” (*fasad*) or chaos is its opposite. See heading (F-S-D).

The Quran has used “فَسَادٌ” (*fasaad*) or chaos against “صَالِحٌ” (*salaah*) i.e. righteousness in (2:11).

Surah *Al-Qasas* uses “مُصْلِحِينَ” (*musleheen*) against “جَبَّارِ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*jabbaran fil ard*) in (28:19). A little later, this root has appeared for good dealings (28:27).

In the Quran “إِنَّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا” (*innallazeena aamano*) it has always been said along with “وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ” (*wa amilussalihaati*) to believe in the permanent values of the Quran as explained, and act righteously.

This shows that both conviction in the permanent values and righteous deeds must go together. The deeds which have no inner self involvement are merely rituals, and delivered mechanically. They cannot

produce good results. Similarly the belief which does not motivate towards righteous deeds is merely a belief in words only and cannot produce results as explained in the Quran.

In surah *Ar-Rom* (30:44), by bringing “مَنْ عَمِلَ صَالِحًا” (*man amela swaleha*) opposite “مَنْ كَفَرَ” (*man kafara*) has made it clear that if good deeds do not accompany it, then all ‘worship’ is useless and your claim to have trust in Allah is meaningless. The righteous deeds too are only those which the Quran has so declared and explained, and not the ones which are good or “صَالِحًا” (*saleha*) in our opinion. These righteous deeds within the domain of the permanent values lead to self-development and help to restore balance in a society when carried out at a collective level. We should note that the Quran has not given a detailed list of these righteous deeds and has quoted a number of generic examples and left it to us to figure out within the requirements of the time, how to live righteously within the permanent values. For example the Quran emphasized on the plight of the poor and deprived repeatedly to invite us to prevent it from happening as this hits at the balance within a society at a fundamental level (107:2-3, 70:24-25). Similarly the Quran has emphasized on keeping commitments and to remain within the domain of the permanent values. The transgression of these values means that in the long term the effects will go against the interest of a society and will result in imbalance. The Quran has given the examples of these imbalances which include divisions into parties, mutual rivalries, bullying, exploitation by the powerful and rich, accumulation of wealth in few hands, civil wars, wars, famines, etc (6:43, 6:65). In other words, the Quran declares that in this life we do have a choice to follow a particular course of action; however, we do not have a choice to alter the effects of following the selected course of action. The Quran explains both the courses of action i.e. the path of “عَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ” (*aamali salehaa and the path of* “سَيِّئَاتٍ” (*sayyiaat*) – it is now upto us to choose anyone and then live by the consequences in our life. We should also keep it in mind that in the moral sphere the effects of our deeds take time to materialize and as the life is one continuous stream which is not interrupted by death, therefore the results will show up at some point in time. Therefore we should select the righteous path as defined by the Quran and develop our character which can help us to live righteous life here and then move on to the next part of our life for further development (16:97).

Sd-L-D

ص ل د

“الصَّلْدُ” (*as-sald*), “السِّلْدُ” (*as-sild*) is a solid, smooth stone {T} (2:264).

“الصَّلْدَاءُ” (*as-salda’u*): solid, hard land which does not grow anything {T}.

“صَلُودٌ” (*salood*): a miser.

“رَأْسٌ صَلْدٌ” (*raasun sald*): a head totally without hair, bald {T}.

“الصَّلْدُ” (*as-sald*) is a rock on which there is no layer of dust. In the verse of surah *Al-Baqrah* (2:264) the above mentioned meanings are evident.

Sd-L-Sd-L

ص ل ص ل

“الصَّلْصَالُ” (*as-salsaal*) is the pure and wet soil in which sand gets mixed. When it is dried, it produces a sound (when struck). When burnt it is called “فَخَّارٌ” (*fakh-khaar*) {T}. That is, dry and raw. Pebble will be called “صَلْصَالٌ” (*salsaal*), and heated pebble will be called “فَخَّارٌ” (*fakh-khaar*).

About the initial stages of the creation of a human being, the Quran says:

15:26	We created man from (ringing) dry earth	وَلَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ صَلْصَالٍ
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Details can be found in the titled “*Iblees and Adam*”.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is of something that has a little dampness and a little water.

The initial life (cells) appears from the mixture of water and soil as modern science has discovered. At other places it has been called as “طِينٌ لَازِبٌ” (*teenil laazib*) as in (37:11), or the physical appearance of initial stages of human physical life.

Since “صلوة” (*salaat*) is an important part of *Deen*, and since the Quran has used this word in different settings, we will deliberate on it in detail. There are two roots referred to this very important term of the Quran - even if this word is based upon (Sd-L-W), many scholars have raised many good points regarding its use when derived from root (Sd-L-Y). Hence both these roots have been combined together in this heading, despite the fact that we have also presented heading (Sd-L-Y) separately as well.

“الصلَا” (*as-salah*) is the middle of the back. It is the place where an animal’s tail grows, or the beginning of the slope of the hip. Both sides of the tail are called “صلَوَان” (*salawaan*). The plural is “صلَوَات” (*salawaat*) or “أَصْلَاء” (*aslaa*) {T}.

“صَلَا” (*sala*), “يَصْلُو” (*yaslu*), “صَلَوْا” (*salwa*) means to strike the “صَلَا” (*sala*).

“صَلَوْتُهُ” (*salautuhu*): I struck him on his “صَلَا” (*sala*) i.e. on his back.

“صَلَّى الْفَرَسُ تَصْلِيَةً” (*sallal farasa tasliyah*) is said when the runner up horse in a race is running very close behind the victor horse. The horse in front is called “سَابِقٌ” (*saabiq*), and the runner up following extremely close is called “الْمُصَلِّي” (*musalli*).

Thus “صَلَّى” (*salla*) means for someone to follow a winner or leader in such a fashion that he is almost touching the leader in front.

One of Ali’s ® statements say:

The Messenger (*pbuh*) went first (i.e. died) and Abu Baker ® followed him closely, and then Umar ® also passed away, leaving the devils making us lose our senses {T}.

سَبَقَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى أَبُو بَكْرٍ وَ تَلَّتْ عُمرُ وَ
خَبَطَتْنَا فَنَتَّ

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “صَلَّى” (*salia*) and “أَصْطَلَى” (*astala*) mean attachment, i.e. to be attached or stuck to someone. That is why *Raghib* has said, that when Quran says “لَمْ نَكُ مِنَ الْمَصْلِيِّينَ” (*lum naku minal musalleen*) in (74:43), it means that “we were not among the followers of the messengers”.

Qurtabi writes therefore that “صلوة” (*salaah*) would mean linked to the commandments of Allah. It would mean to remain within the guidance (limits) set by Allah and to be attached to the Book of Allah i.e. the Quran. As such, “” (*tasliyah*) would mean to follow the one in lead almost in tandem, but never try to pass this leader.

These explanations make the meaning of “صلوة” (*salaah*) clear, but first a preamble must be borne in mind. What is the connection between Allah and his creation with a free will i.e. the man? Allah is the name of that personality (Self) which has the attributes which are the most complete, most consolidated, most lofty and most beautiful. He has granted personality (self) to every human being as well, and called it “روحنا” (*rouhana*) i.e. Divine Energy which gives the ability of freedom to choose. See heading “*Rooh*” for more details. This human self is limited and lower in stature as against Allah’s. For developing its self it has to keep the personality of Allah (i.e. His attributes) before it as an ideal self. We cannot understand anything about Allah Himself (and there is no need for this as well), but the attributes He has described about Himself in the Quran, if reflected upon by us, provide a model for developing our personality. The Quran has described these attributes of Allah as “أَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَى” (*asmaa’al husna*), that is, extremely righteous and infinitely traits. Therefore it is incumbent upon man to keep these traits before him as beacons and to follow them as explained with full commitment to achieve the results as mentioned in the Quran.

The first “صلوة” (*salah*) that we have been invited to desire by the Quran for the attainment of the higher is:

1:5	the desire to find the balanced path which will take us to the higher purpose of our life	إِهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ
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Surah *Hoodh* declares:

11:56	my Rabb (Sustainer) is on the balanced and established path	إِنَّ رَبِّي عَلَى صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ
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It is the same balanced and established path on which the whole visible universe (as an evidence) is being directed and managed (as per Laws) by Allah. We are also provided this option through the Quran to choose to traverse this balanced and established path by opting to follow the guidance explained in the Quran. Therefore “صلوة” (*salaah*) means to reflect the attributes of Allah (so far as it is humanly possible) by adhering to the Quran.

Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:41	Have you not noticed that Allah is the one Who is being followed by whatever there is in (& on) the earth and the heavens, and birds with wings spread out, each one knows its <i>salaat</i> and <i>tasbeeh</i>	أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ يُسَبِّحُ لَهُ مَنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَالطَّيْرِ صَفًّا - كُلٌّ قَدْ عَلِمَ صَلَاتَهُ وَتَسْبِيحَهُ
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This means that everything in the universe knows its duties very well as this is inbuilt within them. It knows which path it must traverse and what its destiny is. These things have been called their “صلوة” (*salaah*) and “تسبيح” (*tasbeeh*). However in the case of human beings since we have a free will therefore we cannot be restrained through an inbuilt guidance for example like birds and animals. While our physical body follows the physical laws our self (consists of ‘I’, emotions, thoughts, memory – more details under *N-F-S*) being nonphysical does not follow these laws and needs external guidance as an option, which can be accepted through the use of our free volition. In other words to know our “صلوة” (*salaah*) and “تسبيح” (*tasbeeh*), we need to first have a desire to explore the alternatives available to us as a guidance and then using our intellect and reasoning accept the permanent values given in the Quran. There is nothing inbuilt within us which can direct us to the Quran automatically as this goes against the free will. Since each human being is endowed with this self, he/she has to make a choice at some stage of their life if they wish to make a different choice or are quite happy and satisfied with their existing choice i.e. the choices of the society around them, The Quran has referred to this point at many places e.g. (74:37), (83:26), (78:39). The human self can only develop when it willingly makes a choice to live within the permanent values of the Quran.

2:3	And establish and follow Allah’s laws	وَيُؤَيِّمُونَ الصَّلَاةَ
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Recognising that individuals need to change first to conform to the values of the Quran and then work to establish a system based on these values. The collective system will then provide the environment for the self-development which is essential to progress in this direction. This will also provide an environment for those who wish to follow this path of self-development.

This is the reason why the Quran has used plurals for these words, so much so, that it has mentioned the duty of an Islamic state to be:

22:41	These are the people who when get established in the earth work to establish <i>salaat</i> and provide <i>zakat</i> and through this promote good and prevent evil.	الَّذِينَ إِنْ مَكَّنَّاهُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ أَقَامُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآتَوُا الزَّكَاةَ وَآمَرُوا بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَنَهَوْا عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ
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For the meaning of *zakaat*, see heading (Z-K-W).

At another place they have been called:

9:112	those who do the <i>ruku</i> and <i>sajdah</i>	الَّذِينَ هُمْ يُرْكَعُونَ السَّاجِدُونَ
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For the meanings of *ruku* and *sajdah*, see heading (R-K-Ain) and (S-J-D).

This is the reason that mutual consultation has been mentioned for settling both affairs of the state and the establishing of the *salaat*:

42:38	they establish the <i>salaat</i> and their affairs are decided by mutual consultation	أَقَامُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآمَرُوهُمْ شُؤْرَىٰ بَيْنَهُمْ
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Since all matters of the *momineem* are decided according to the permanent values of the Quran, surah *Al-Airaaf* has kept phrases like “تَمَسُّكَ بِالْكِتَابِ” (*tamas suk bil kitaab*) and “أَقَامَتِ صَلَوةَ” (*aqamatis salaah*) together in (7:170). It means establishing a society in which all individuals follow the laws given by the Quran and thus be attached to the book of Allah. For more details on this point in the Quran, “تَوَلَّى” (*tawalla*) has come opposite to “صَلَّى” (*salla*), as in (75:30-31).

“تَوَلَّى” (*tawalla*) means to turn away from the right path or find ways to circumvent it, or turn away from it. This is all done deliberately. Hence “صَلَّى” (*salla*) would mean to follow the right path as per Allah’s laws. To perform the duties according to the Quran, *Allama Hameeduddin Farahi* says that “صَلَاةَ” (*salaah*) means to proceed towards a direction, to face or fix the direction towards something, to be attentive {*Mufardaatul Quran*}.

Surah *Al-Alaq* says:

96:9	when Allah’s servant wishes to discharge his duties	أَرْنَيْتَ الَّذِي يُبْهِى عَبْدًا أَصْلَى
96:10	, then his opponent puts obstacles in his path	

These duties encompass every facet of life. As such, the Quran says in surah *Hoodh* that *Shoaib*’s nation said to him:

11:87	Does your <i>salaat</i> tell you that we abandon what our forefathers had been doing, or we cannot even spend our wealth as we wish to?	أَصْلَوْنَكُمْ تَأْمُرُكُمْ أَنْ تَتَّخِذُوا مَا يَعْْبُدُ آبَاؤُنَا أَوْ أَنْ تَفْعَلَ فِي أَمْوَالِنَا مَا نَشَاءُ
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That is, they did not wish to have a sort of *salaat* which was (as preached by *Shoaib*) encompassing day to day economics? This too explains the meaning of *salaat*, i.e. to follow the permanent values in every facet of life.

The basic issue in this discussion is that whether man should decide his matters of life according to his own wishes or according to the guidance provided by the revelation from Allah? To decide all matters as of his life using the Quranic Guidance is what establishment of *salaat* is. By bringing “أقامتِ صَلَوةَ” (*aqamatis salaah*) i.e. establishing *Salaat* and “اتَّبَاعَ جَذَبَاتٍ” (*itba-i jazbaat*) i.e. following one’s own desires opposite to each other the Quran has further elaborated.

It is said:

19:59	(After the messengers) people abandoned <i>salaat</i> and started following their own negative desires	فَخَلَفَ مِنْ بَعْدِ خُلْفٍ أَصَاغُوا لَصَلْوَةٍ وَ اتَّبَعُوا الشَّهَوَاتِ -
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This means that by following his own wishes man abandons *salaat*, and by following the permanent values of the Quran he establishes it.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says that whoever protects *salaat* is the one who has belief in the life of the hereafter and this belief is then linked to the Quran (6:92). That is why *Ibn Qateeba* has said that “الصلوة” (*is-salaat*) means the same as “الدين” (*ad-deen*) {*Alqartain Vol.1 page 13*}. In other words, establishing *salaat* means the same as establishing the *Deen*, or the Quranic way of life.

“أَصْلَى” (*as-sala*) also means fire and its fuel.

“صَلَّى عَصَاهُ عَلَى النَّارِ” (*sala asahu alun naar*): he turned his staff soft by heating it in the fire, and straightened it.

“صَلَّى” (*salla*) also means that he removed the fire and moved it away {*Roohul Maani*}.

Looked at from this angle, *salaat* would mean to remove one’s faults.

Al minar says that “صَلَاةٌ قَوْلًا وَعَمَلًا” (*salaata qaulan wa amlan*) is the acknowledgement of the truth that we need the guidance of a personality that is faultless for removing our own faults.

Qurtabi says that *salaat* means to willingly accept submission to Allah and His obedience.

According to {*Muheet*} One meaning of **salaat** is to subjugate and make someone lean towards itself. This way **salaat** would mean to conquer the universe (dominate it) and make it ‘submit’ i.e. serve one’s purpose or make use of its potentials for the benefit of mankind.

Another meaning of “الصلوة” (**as-salaat**) is to pay respect and gratitude {*T*}, i.e. to pay homage to the Rabb (Sustainer) of the worlds through one’s righteous deeds – to acknowledge through demonstrating the extreme goodness which is associated with the human creation when we follow the permanent values of the Quran. This also makes the connection between “اقامت صلوة” (**aqamatis salaat**), that is, establishment of **salaat**, and provide **zakat**. In other words it would mean to establish a system according to Allah’s laws and to actually follow this program so that the entire mankind is nurtured.

The above meanings of **salaat** make it clear that an obedient person (Muslim) will establish **salaat** by acting on the permanent values of the Quran in every segment of life. There is no need for any particular time, form or place for this **salaat** - **it is something which compasses whole life with no exception**.

Having explained this, there are some verses in the Quran where **salaat** has been used to denote a particular act. For example:

5:6	Believers, when you stand for salaat , then wash your faces and forearms up to the elbows; and caress your hands over your head; and wash your feet up to the ankles; and if you do not have water then do the ‘ tayammuum ’	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِذَا قُمْتُمْ إِلَى الصَّلَاةِ فَاغْسِلُوا وُجُوهَكُمْ وَأَيْدِيَكُمْ إِلَى الْمَرَافِقِ وَامْسَحُوا بِرُءُوسِكُمْ وَأَرْجُلَكُمْ إِلَى الْكَعْبَيْنِ
4:43	Believers, do not go near salaat when you are in a stupor (drunk or sleepy) until you comprehend what you are saying by mouth	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَقْرَبُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَأَنْتُمْ سُكَارَىٰ - حَتَّىٰ تَعْلَمُوا مَا تَقُولُونَ
4:102	And when you establish salaat for them than one group should be armed and stand in salaat with you and when they have performed the sajdah before Allah, they should go to the rear and the other group may establish salaat with you and they too should have their weapons with them for their safety	إِذَا كُنْتَ فِيهِمْ فَأَقَمْتَ لَهُمُ الصَّلَاةَ فَلْتَقُمْ طَائِفَةٌ مِنْهُمْ مَعَكَ وَلْيَأْخُذُوا أَسْلِحَتَهُمْ - فَإِذَا سَجَدُوا فَلْيَكُونُوا مِنْ وَرَائِكُمْ - وَلْتَأْتِ طَائِفَةٌ أُخْرَىٰ لَمْ يُصَلُّوا فَلْيُصَلُّوا مَعَكَ وَلْيَأْخُذُوا أَعْدَرَهُمْ وَاسْلِحَتَهُمْ -
4:102	when you have performed (completed) the salaat , then you should remember Allah (The message) , whether standing, sitting or lying down; and when you are at peace then perform the salaat	فَإِذَا قَضَيْتُمُ الصَّلَاةَ فَادْكُرُوا اللَّهَ قِيَامًا وَقُعُودًا أَوْ عَلَىٰ جُنُوبِكُمْ - فَإِذَا طُمَأْنِنْتُمْ فَاقْبَلُوا الصَّلَاةَ -

The verse before this says:

4:101	And when you are traveling, there is no harm if you shorten your salaat and also if you fear any action from those who deny (opponents may harm you)	فَإِذَا اضْرَبْتُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَلَيْسَ عَلَيْكُمْ جُنَاحٌ أَنْ تَقْصُرُوا مِنَ الصَّلَاةِ إِنْ خِفْتُمْ أَنْ يَفْتِنَكُمُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا -
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In this respect see also (2:239).

The manner in which **salaat** can be shortened has been given in (4:102).

Surah **Al-Ma'idah** says:

5:58	and when you call for prayers then the opponents make fun of it	وَإِذَا نَادَيْتُمْ إِلَى الصَّلَاةِ اتَّخَذُوا هَاهُنَا وَأُفْعَىٰ -
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Surah *Al-Jumah* says:

62:9-10	When the call to <i>salaat</i> is announced on the day of Friday, then leave whatever you are doing (even if it is business) and come to the remembrance of Allah. If you recognize the importance of this then you would understand how good this is for you. When <i>salaat</i> has ended, then you can spread out in the land and seek the benevolence of Allah, and keep Allah in remembrance a lot so that you prosper in life.	إِذْ يُؤَدَّى لِلصَّلَاةِ مِنَ يَوْمِ الْجُمُعَةِ فَاسْعَوْا إِلَى ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ وَذَرُوا الْبَيْعَ - ذَالِكُمْ خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ - فَإِذَا قُضِيَ الصَّلَاةُ فَانْتَشِرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَابْتَغُوا مِنْ فَضْلِ اللَّهِ وَاذْكُرُوا اللَّهَ كَثِيرًا لَّعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ
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After this, it is said that these people are such that if they find some attractions, they run towards them and leave you standing alone. Tell them that whatever you can get of Allah is better than any attraction or business, and that Allah is the best provider of sustenance (62:11).

The above explanations show that the Quran has also used the word *salaat* to mean the congregations of what we call “*namaaz*” or prayer. This word “*namaaz*” is not Arabic but Persian. Note an important thing about these congregations. The worship of Allah does not mean the sort of worship that we see in temples (bowing and scraping etc.). According to the Quran, the worship of Allah is in obeying his orders and act accordingly. This subjugation will, of course, encompass every sector of life, and its practical shape is the system of state that is established according to the Quranic values.

About the management of such a system, it is said:

42:38	These are the people who obey their Sustainer or Lord) and establish the <i>salaat</i> : and their affairs are decided by mutual consultation: and whatever We give them, they keep it available for mankind (hallmark of such a system)	وَالَّذِينَ اسْتَجَابُوا لِرَبِّهِمْ وَأَقَامُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَأَمْرُهُمْ شُورَى بَيْنَهُمْ وَمِمَّا رَزَقْنَاهُمْ يُنفِقُونَ
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The connection between the obedience of Allah, establishment of *salaat* and mutual consultation in human affairs is to be noted here. It is obvious that for mutual consultations there will have to be congregations and meetings and these will form part of establishment and management of *salaat*.

Another reality which one needs to keep in mind is as mentioned earlier, that man sometimes manifests his emotions through physical movements (body language) and these are entirely reflex movements. Sadness, anger, happiness, surprise, adamanacy, yes and no, are all emotions which are displayed by physical movements of the body. The same applies to the emotions of respect and obedience. For showing respect and obedience, a man can bow his head. Although the Quran keeps the veracity and spirit of the act, and not the forms itself, it does not prevent the forms where the movements signify some act, provided that the form itself is not thought to be everything. The forms of *ruku* and *sajdah* etc. that are part of the *namaz* (prayers) are also for this purpose. It is also obvious that when these movements that display some emotion are collective then they must also be uniform, otherwise there would seem to be disharmony and chaos. To keep discipline in the display of emotions of respect and obedience and faithfulness, is in itself a way to display self-discipline. This then is the strong manifestation of forms of acceptance and obedience which the Quran describes as a necessary part of the meetings and consultation of a group of *Momineen*. We also begin our public meetings with recitations from the holy Quran, although this is done only ceremoniously – the Quran should encompass the business of whole collective life and not for just recitations.

42:38	And these are those who respond to their Sustainer and establish <i>Salaat</i>	وَالَّذِينَ اسْتَجَابُوا لِرَبِّهِمْ وَأَقَامُوا الصَّلَاةَ
42:38	And their affairs are conducted by consultation among them	وَأَمْرُهُمْ شُورَى بَيْنَهُمْ

In view of the importance of these congregations, the Quran has called them “كِتَابًا مُؤَقَّتًا” (*kitabau mauqoota*) in (4:103) which means “particularly fixed duties”, and the second meaning is “a duty which is discharged timely”. The timeliness for the congregations is essential.

As such, the verse of Surah **Al-Jumma** which has appeared before, says that when the call for this congregation is given, then leave aside all business and come immediately to it, and until it has been completed, do not attend any other business.

The life of the **Momineen** is spent in obedience of Allah's laws morning, day and night. But the fixation of timings for congregations is necessary.

The Quran, while demolishing other beliefs of the time about things being lucky or unlucky, has shown by setting timings for prayer during night and day that no time is lucky or unlucky. As far as the prayer congregations are concerned:

17:78	and the entire time from morning to evening, you can establish salaat till the darkness of the night	أَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ لِلذِّكْرِ الشَّمْسِ إِلَى غَسَقِ اللَّيْلِ وَقُرْآنَ الْفَجْرِ--
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It is pointing to especially when the sun rises, it is overhead or reaches the middle of the day, and when the sun begins to set and actually sets. By pointing to these timings it intended to end the superstitions that so and so time was lucky or so and so time was unlucky.

11:114	Establish salaat at both ends of the day and parts of the night.	وَأَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ طَرَفِي النَّهَارِ وَزُلْفَاءَ اللَّيْلِ
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These timings have been mentioned especially with the word **salaat**, but in order to establish **Deen** all times of the day and night have been mentioned. See (3:190), (20:130), (50:39) and (52:49)zsss.

In surah **An-Noor**, the **salaat** of morning and evening have been mentioned where it is said that your servants should ask your permission before coming in at times of privacy.

24:58	Before the morning prayer (early morning), and when you take off your shirts in the afternoon (due to heat) and want to rest (as is done throughout Arabia) and after the salaat at night.	مِنْ قَبْلِ صَلَاةِ الْفَجْرِ وَحِينَ تَضَعُونَ ثِيَابَكُمْ مِنَ الظَّهْرِ وَمِنْ بَعْدِ صَلَاةِ الْعِشَاءِ
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This shows that during time of the Messenger (**pbuh**), **salaat** was fixed for at least two times a day. That is why the Quran has mentioned these by name.

As far as reciting something during prayer, we have already seen that the Quran has said that you must know what you are saying or reciting (4:43). At another place it is said:

17:110	And do not recite during your salaat in a loud voice or too quietly but adopt a way in between	وَلَا تُجْهَرُ بِصَلَاتِكَ وَلَا تُخَافِتُ بِهَا- وَابْتَغِ بَيْنَ ذَلِكَ سَبِيلًا
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Some think that here **salaat** means common prayer or mention, but not prayer conducted in gathering. This does appear to be right, since there is an explicit explanation about “**zkr**” (**zkr**) or mention in the Quran (7:205). It says that it should be done quietly at heart.

“**zkr**” (**zkr**) means the mention of the laws of Allah. That is why this **salaat** can only be prayers.

Qurtabi has said that it means recitation.

The above shows that **salaat** means the congregations of prayer. For it, the verb used, is “**صَلَّى**” (**salli**) or “**يُصَلِّي**” (**yusalli**). It means that when the Quran says “**اقموا الصلوة**” (**aqimus salaata**) it means the establishment of Deen i.e. the formation and strengthening of the system of Allah's laws. The obedience of Allah's laws, the discharge of duties that are incumbent on a **Momin**, but at some places they do mean the congregations of **salaat** which are themselves a part of Deen. At the relevant places one has to see as to what “**اقامت صلوة**” (**aqaaamatis salaata**) means. Similarly, wherever “**مصلين**” (**musalleen**) has appeared, it will have to be seen whether the entire group of Momineen is meant or only those who take part in the

salaat congregation, because the Quran has also mentioned “مصلين” (*musalleen*) who are extremely righteous . See (70:22-35), and those have also been mentioned for whom there is destruction (107:4-7).

Raghib says “صَلَّى عَلَيْهِ” (*salla alaihi*) means to respect, to pray for, to encourage, to nurture, to develop, to allow no ill or chaos to be created.

Keep these meanings in mind wherever this root has appeared with *ala's salah*.

In surah *Al-Ahzaab* the group of *Momineen* has been told:

33:43	Allah and the <i>malaikah</i> (forces of the universe) encourage you and provide the means for your sustenance to develop your efforts.	هُوَ الَّذِي يُصَلِّي عَلَيْكُمْ وَمَلَائِكَتُهُ--
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This has been said about those *momineen* who do not worry or flounder if faced with difficulties while establishing the *Deen*. They do not lose courage but instead fight those difficulties stolidly.

2:157	These people are worthy of commendation before their Sustainer	أُولَئِكَ عَلَيْهِمْ صَلَوَاتٌ مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ
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They have the support of Allah. Allah encourages them, and makes their efforts yield good results and develops them. This is about the common *Momineen*.

About *Muhammed (pbuh)* himself, it is said:

33:56	Allah and his <i>malaika</i> encourage the Messenger.	إِنَّ اللَّهَ وَمَلَائِكَتَهُ يُصَلُّونَ عَلَى النَّبِيِّ
33:59	O'group of <i>Momineen</i> , you too must assist the Messenger in making the program successful Help him in his efforts.	أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا صَلُّوا عَلَيْهِ وَسَلِّمُوا تَسْلِيمًا

This can be done in a practical way by obeying him fully, and showing him respect (4:65).

About the *Momineen* it is said at another place:

7:157	Respect and agreed with him, help him, and follow him and the Book that We revealed to him.	وَعَزَّزُوهُ وَنَصَرُوهُ وَاتَّبِعُوا النُّورَ الَّذِي أُنْزِلَ مَعَهُ
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This is how *momineen* should discharge the duty of “صَلُّوا عَلَيْهِ” (*sallu alaihi*).

This is the *salatun* of Allah and His *malaika* on the party of *Momineen* and on the Messenger (*pbuh*) himself, and this is the *momineen's* “صَلَوَاتُ” (*salawat*) and *salaam* on the Messenger.

Note how great an action plan is called for by the order of “صَلُّوا عَلَيْهِ وَسَلِّمُوا تَسْلِيمًا” (*sallu aliaihi wa sallimu tasleema*), i.e. by the complete obedience of Allah's laws to establish this *Deen* on all the *deens* of the World and which was brought to us by *Muhammed (pbuh)*. On the other hand the Messenger (*pbuh*) has been told to accept whatever contributions the *Momineen* bring to him with a view to redistribute it within the needy and deprived to restore the balance.

9:103	And encourage them: because your encouragement and appreciation is cause for much satisfaction to them	وَصَلِّ عَلَيْهِمْ إِنَّ صَلَاتَكَ سَكَنٌ لَهُمْ
9:99	They consider this to be closer to Allah and encouragement and commendation from the messenger.	فُزِّلَتْ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ وَصَلَوَاتُ الرَّسُولِ

For the meaning of “closeness to Allah”, see heading (Q-R-B).

In the Hebrew language, “صَلَوَاتُ” (*salawaat*) also means places of worship for Jews. Verse (22:40) uses this word in this meaning.

“صَلَّى اللَّحْمَ يَصْلِيهِ بِالنَّارِ صَلَّى” (*sallal lahama yaslihi bin naari salya*): “he barbequed meat”, or “he put the meat into fire to barbeque it”.

“الصَّلَى” (*as-salyu*) actually means to light a fire.

“صَلَّى بِالنَّارِ” (*saliya bin naar*): he suffered pain of the fire (of burning). He burned in fire.

“صَلَّيْتُ الشَّاةَ” (*salaitush shah*): I barbequed a goat {R}.

“أَصْلَاهُ النَّارَ وَصْلَاهُ” (*as laahun naara was salaah*): he put it into fire to burn, made the fire its destination {M}.

“الصَّلَاءُ” (*as-silaa*): a thing which is barbequed. It also means fuel for lighting a fire {T}.

“صَالٍ” (*saal*): that which burns in fire,

“مَنْ بُو صَالٍ الْجَحِيمِ” (*mun huwa saalil jaheem*): which goes towards Jahannam (37:163).

“الصِّلَى” (*as-silly*): to burn, to bear the pain of burning (19:70).

The Quran says:

87:12	He who enters or is trapped into a very big fire	الَّذِي يَصْلَى النَّارَ الْكُبْرَى
69:31	then let him enter Jahannam to burn	ثُمَّ الْجَحِيمِ صَلْوُهُ
74:26	I will burn him in hell	سَأُصْلِيهِ سَقَرَ
56:94	to burn in hell	تَصْلِيَةً جَحِيمِ

“إِصْطَلَى” (*istala*), or “إِصْطَلَى” (*istala*): to warm up off fire and get heat from it.

27:7	So you may warm yourself	لَعَلَّكُمْ تَصْطَلُونَ
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“الصَّمْتُ” (*as-samtu*), “الصُّمُوتُ” (*as-sumoot*), “الصَّمَاتُ” (*as-samaat*): to be quiet.

For the difference between “سَكَتَ” (*sakata*) and “صَمَتَ” (*samata*), see the heading (S-K-T).

Ibn Faris says it basically means ambiguity.

7:193	you remain quiet	أَنْتُمْ صَامِتُونَ
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“الصَّامِتُ” (*as-saamit*): gold and silver (wealth which cannot speak).

“بِرِخْلَافِ الْأَنْطِقِ” (*an-naatiq*): wealth in the shape of animals.

“الصُّمُوتُ” (*as-samoot*): a sword which strikes deep and gets stuck into its target.

“حَائِطٌ مُصْمَتٌ” (*ha'itun musmut*): a wall without any opening {T, M}.

“الصَّمْدُ” (*as-samd*): a high place, but not as high as a mountain.

“الصَّمْدَةُ” (*as-samdah*): a solid, stone rock.

“الصَّمَدُ” (*as-samad*): the leader which is obeyed and without whom no decision is taken. The being towards whom referral is made (who is looked towards) to meet the needs. Hence it means a being who cannot be done without, or a person who is not bothered by hunger or thirst in battle.

“نَاقَةٌ مِصْمَادٌ” (*naaqatun mismaad*): a she camel which gives milk despite severe cold and lack of fodder {T, M}.

“صِمْدُ الْمِحْرَاثِ” (*simdul hijraat*): a wooden stick of plough which the farmer holds in his hand while sloughing {T, M}.

“الصَّمْدُ” (*as-samd*): to intend to {T, M}.

The Quran has mentioned Allah as “الصَّمَدُ” (*as-samad*) in (112:2). Deliberate on the meanings given above and then wonder as to how deep a concept about Allah the Quran has presented by calling him “الصَّمَدُ” (*as-samad*), i.e. like a high ground or strong and solid rock which is unaffected by the floods around it. People turn to it when they don’t find refuge elsewhere and get sanctuary there. Also the being which meets the needs of others but is above all needs. Also that his benevolence is unceasing and his sustenance is continuous. If these traits can be reflected in a nation then it can certainly rise to great heights. In getting to its purpose, hunger and thirst do not bother it, and winter and drought do not deter it from the sustenance of others. It becomes solid as a rock and a solace to the helpless, but totally independent of others’ support.

By saying “قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ - اللَّهُ الصَّمَدُ” (*qul hu Allahu ahad, allah hus samad*) in (112:1-2), the Quran has pointed to another great reality. “أَحَدٌ” (*ahad*) means unique. This uniqueness indicates transcendence (or being above). But “صَمَدِيَّةٌ” (*samadiyat*) means that every single breadth a man takes is linked to His sustenance. This shows his immanence which is the quality a Momin should also reflect. That is “أَحَدِيَّةٌ” (*ahadiyat*) and “صَمَدِيَّةٌ” (*samadiyat*), or needlessness.

Allah’s personality is the greatest and highest, i.e. it is the most developed, complete and perfect personality. He has endowed man with a personality, but in an undeveloped form. The different names of Allah as defined in the Quran are actually the traits that He possesses, and are the different facets of his personality. Some are particular to Allah only, as for example “هُوَ الْأَوَّلُ” (*huwal awwalu*), but others can be reflected in human beings (to the extent possible for humans). These include “صَمَدِيَّةٌ” (*samadiyat*). This means that as human personality develops, it will be independent of other supports, but be the cause for supporting others. *Freedom and independence are the basic traits of personality.*

More details can be seen under the headings (W-W-H) and (N-F-S).

Sd-M-Ain ص م ع

“الْأَصْمَعُ” (*al-asm*): a man with small ears.

“ظَبْيٌ مُصَمَّعٌ” (*zabyun musamma*): a deer with horns which have pointed ends.

“أَصْوَمَعَةٌ” (*as-sauma’a*): eagle, because it flies high.

“صَوْمَعَةٌ” (*sauma’ah*): a monastic place of worship, because its dome was pointed at the top like that of a church or temple, or because of its narrowness as a man with small ears. But this meaning seems more appropriate with reference to height, because it is said “صَوْمَعٌ بِنَاءٌ” (*sauma’ha bina’hu*): he raised his building.

“أَصْمَعُ” (*asma’a*): someone who progresses to the top post or place.

“صَمِيعٌ” (*samih*): he was engaged in his thoughts and went past without a care {*T, M, R, Latif-ul-lugha*}.

“صَوَامِعُ” (*samih*) is the plural of “صَوْمَعَةٌ” (*sauma’ah*) as in (22:40) and means hermitages i.e. the small rooms of the monists {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings of this root imply fineness and joining. That is, for something to be fine and at the same time for its elements to be intertwined together.

Sd-M-M ص م م

“صَمَمَ” (*samam*) means for the ear to close, or to have lack of hearing {*T, M, R*}.

“صِمَامُ الْقَارُورَةِ” (*simamal qaarura*): the cork of a bottle with which its opening is closed.

“صَخْرَةٌ صَمَاءٌ” (*sakhratan samma’u*): solid and hard rock without any opening or hole.

“الْأَصْمُ” (*al-asammu*) means deaf. Plural is “صُمٌّ” (*soomm*). It also means a person who does not pay heed to anyone and who believes that he cannot be prevented from what he wishes {*T, M*}.

“الْمُصَمِّمُ” (*al-musammim*): a camel which does not blabber, and continues onward very stolidly {*T, M*}.

The Quran has used the word “صُمٌّ” (*soom*) for the deaf. It has also been used for those who do not heed the voice of reason and do what they want. They are like animals without the ability to reflect. They do not use their thought and intellect to see the truth (8:22). They do not think with their minds and do not

see reason or brook any reasoning. They simply follow the wrong path as if they were blind, deaf or even dead.

“أَصَمَّ” (*aasam*): to make deaf (27:23).

Sd-N-Ain ص ن ع

“صَنَعَ” (*sana*) means to do something well using technique, craftsmanship and within the law. Therefore this word is a verb (action oriented) and is not used for animals {R}.

“صُنْعٌ” (*sunaa*): very good artisanship.

27:88	Allah’s workmanship is wonderful. He has made everything expertly.	صُنْعَ اللَّهِ الَّذِي أَتَقَنَ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ
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“صَنَعَهُ” (*san’ah*): to make something expertly (21:80).

“الْمَصْنَعُ” (*al-masanih*): buildings, pool or pond in which rain water is accumulated, palaces, forts, dwellings, as well as factories etc.

Ibn Faris says it means a well which is built for irrigation purposes.

Raghib says it means lofty, respected, and awesome places (26:129).

“صَنَعَ الْفَرَسَ” (*sana al fars*) means to train and groom a horse in a good way.

“هُوَ صَنِيعِي” (*huwa saniyi*): he is my trainee {T}.

In surah *Taha* Allah says about *Moosa*:

20:39	We took you to the palaces of the Pharaoh so that you could be trained there under our Guidance and you learned statesmanship	لِنُصْنَعَ عَلَى عَيْنِي
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This shows that *Moosa* was chosen to be a messenger right from birth. He was brought to Pharaoh’s palace to be trained by the Egyptians in the matters of state. All this was according to God’s plan. This made him capable of holding a great mantle like messenger hood. That is why when the life before messenger-hood of *Moosa* has been discussed, it has been stated that after passing through so many challenges , he had passed the criteria for (holding) messenger hood (20:40),

The messenger-hood is not granted suddenly and in a fickle way, but it is a well thought out, planned and executed divine programme.

“الْإِصْطِنَاعُ” (*alistinaah*) means to work very hard at improving something. It means to train and rectify with great attention and care {T}.

Hence the verse further ahead says:

20:40	your training has been undertaken with a certain programme in mind, because We needed you to do ‘our work’	ثُمَّ جِئْتُ عَلَى قَدَرٍ يُؤَسِّرُ
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All this has been done for a certain purpose. What is that purpose?

20:24	Go to the Pharaoh: he has transgressed the defined bounds and has become rebellious	إِذْ هَبَّ إِلَى فِرْعَوْنَ إِنَّهُ طَغَى
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The purpose is to deliver humanity from the clutches of oppression through human hands and to train them in a way that they can lead the humanity. This is the purpose for which messengers were trained and which has been described as ‘God’s own interest’. Note that during all this period, a messenger himself

did not know that he was being prepared for the messenger-hood. Therefore, to believe that man can reach the status of a messenger through his endeavors is wrong and an incorrect concept.

Sd-N-M ص ن م

“الصَّنَم” (*as-sanam*) means idol or statue. Its plural is “أَصْنَامٌ” (*asnaam*).
 “صَنَّمَ الصُّورَةَ” (*sanamas soorah*) means to make a picture attractive and pleasing to the eye {T}. It also means for something to become foul smelling.

Raghib says that some scholars think that anything which makes man aloof from Allah and turns his attention to others is called “صَنَمٌ” (*sanam*).

“أَصْنَامٌ” (*asnaam*) are all those pleasures and interests that make man shun Allah’s laws.

Raghib says that **Ibrahim**’s prayer means:

14:35	O God, prevent me and my progeny from worshipping <i>asnaam</i>	وَاجْتَنِبْنِي وَبَنِيَّ أَنْ نَعْبُدَ الْأَصْنَامَ
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Here this word means such things (as mentioned before) because **Ibrahim** certainly didn’t apprehend that his progeny would indulge in idolatry..

The Quran says:

12:106	Most of them believe in Allah but at the same time assoiiate others with Him	وَمَا يُؤْمِنُ أَكْثَرُهُمْ بِاللَّهِ إِلَّا وَهُمْ مُشْرِكُونَ
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We pass by this verse lightly because we think it is not about us because certainly we do not worship any idol. We believe that we do not worship any idols of stones, but we fail to see which (gods) rule our minds (such as greed, celebrities, false beliefs, parents, rulers, our own desires, etc.) which dominate our minds every second, and which we take to the mosques along with us.

What can be more idol worshipping than having other thoughts except Allah’s in our minds? The apprehension that rose in the mind of **Ibrahim** many years ago, are being proven right today. These beliefs affect us and we are unable to be righteous as the Quran has directed us to be.

Sd-N-W ص ن و

“الصَّنَوُ” (*as-sinwu*): the branches which grow from the roots of date palms and other trees. Plural is “صِنَوَانٌ” (*sinwaan*) {T, M, R}. As such, “نَخِيلٌ صِنَوَانٌ” (*nakheelun sinwaan*) is a date palm which has two or more trunks sprouting from the same base (13:4).
 “غَيْرُ صِنَوَانٍ” (*ghairu sinwaan*) are the trunks which grow as single “لَصْنَوَةٌ” (*as-sanwah*) means real sister, daughter or aunt, while “الصَّنَوُ” (*as-sinwu*) means real brother, son, or uncle, because all these are branches of the same tree.

Sd-He-He ص ه ر

“الصَّهْرُ” (*as-sahr*): hot.
 “شَيْءٌ صَهْرٌ” (*shaiyun sahr*): hot thing.
 “الصَّهْرُ” (*as-sahr*): to melt fat etc by heating it.
 “صَهْرَتُهُ الشَّمْسُ تَصْهَرُ” (*saharatush shamsau tashar*): intense heat of the sun boiled one’s head, melting his fat.
 “صَهْرَتُهُ بِالنَّارِ” (*sartuhu bin naar*): I melted it over fire.
 “الصَّهَارَةُ” (*as-suhaarah*): melted fat {T, M, R}.

Surah **Al-Hajj** says:

22:20	Through it (with it), We shall melt whatever there is inside them.	يُصْهَرُ بِهِ مَا فِي بُطُونِهِمْ
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	(Their arrogance and stubbornness will be melted away)	
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“الصَّيْرُ” (*is-sihr*): nearness, closeness. There are many meanings of this word, but most think that family members from one's wife's side are called “أَصْهَارُ” (*as-haar*) and the husband's family is called “أَخْتَانُ” (*aakhtaan*).

The Quran says:

25:54	And made relationships of blood and marriage for him	فَجَعَلَهُ نَسَبًا وَصِهْرًا
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“نَسَبُ” (*nasb*) means the relation that is from one's ancestors' side, while “صِهْرُ” (*sihr*) is the relationship that is acquired through marriage {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran gives importance to family life, however, righteousness is the most important criterion (49:13). It calls people from both sides of husband and wife as shared relatives.

Sd-W-B ص و ب

“صَابَ” (*saab*), “يَصُوبُ” (*yasoob*), “صَوْبًا” (*sauban*) means to fall, to come down from above, to intend for rain to fall down.

“صَوَّبَ” (*sabun*) and “صَوَّابٌ” (*sawab*) means the opposite of error, i.e. the right thing.

Ibn Faris says that it basically means for something to come down and then reach its destination.

“صَوَّابٌ” (*sawaab*) is a thing which reaches its right place.

“سَهْمٌ صَائِبٌ” (*sahmun saa-ib*) means the arrow which hits the target.

“صَوَّبَ” (*saub*) also means to let flow, drop, and to come down from above. It also means to rain from the skies. “مُصِيبَةٌ” (*museebah*) is the arrow which finds its target. After that, every event and accident came to be known as “مُصِيبَةٌ” (*museebah*).

“تَصْوِيبٌ” (*tasweeb*) means to verify something as right.

“الصَّيْبُ” (*as-sayyib*) means rain {*T*}.

Lissan-ul-Arab says that “صَيَّبَ” (*sayyib*) means a cloud that brings rain.

“أَصَابَ مِنَ الْمَرْأَةِ” (*asaba min al-mar'ah*): kissed a woman and had sex with her. That is, fulfilled his need with her {*M*}.

The Quran has used “صَيَّبَ” (*sayyib*) to mean rain (or rain bearing cloud) in (2:18).

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:34	The results of the evil deeds which they indulged in, reached them and the coming events which they used to make fun, encircled them	فَأَصَابَهُمْ سَيِّئَاتُ مَا عَمِلُوا وَخَاقٌ بِهِمْ يَسْتَهْرُونَ
38:36	the way he intended to go	حَيْثُ أَصَابَ
78:38	he should say right and correct thing	قَالَ صَوَّابًا

Here “أَصَابَ” (*asaab*) means for something to happen.

“أَصَابَهُ الْكِبَرُ” (*asabahul kibar*): he reached old age (2:266).

Surah *An-Nisaa* has used “فَاضَلُ” (*fazl*) against “مُصِيبَةٌ” (*museebah*) in (4:72-73). As such, “مُصِيبَةٌ” (*museebah*) means economic ill being or lack of success. In (9:50) “مُصِيبَةٌ” (*museebah*) has come against “حَسَنَةٌ” (*hasanah*). Hence it means the unevenness or unpleasantness of life.

Surah *At-Taghabun* says:

64:11	The events and accidents that appear in the	مَا أَصَابَ مِنْ مُصِيبَةٍ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ
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	universe all happen due to Allah's laws	
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Here “مُصِيبَةٌ” (*museebah*) means event or accident.
 “اذن” (*izn*): law. See heading (A-Dh-N).

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:56	we impart our benevolence to whom we will according to our Will	نُصِيبُ بِرَحْمَتِنَا مَنْ نَشَاءُ
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This explains that this pleasant phase in life for *Yusuf* was due to Allah's benevolence, but messenger-hood is not the result of any human effort.

“بعد ولا نضيق أجراً للمحسنين” (*museebun*) means that which is to take place, or yet to reach (11:81).

Sd-W-T ص و ت

“الصَّوْتُ” (*as-saut*) with plural form “أَصْوَاتُ” (*aswaat*) means sound. It means voice of a human or non-human.

“الصَّائِتُ” (*as-saa'it*): someone who screams.

“رَجُلٌ صَاتٌ” (*rajulun saat*): a man with a harsh voice {T}.

Muheet says it means sound emitted from the mouth. It is not a word, but is called “صَوْتُ” (*saut*) some noise.

Raghib says that the air trapped by the clashing of two bodies is called “صَوْتُ” (*saut*) but this meaning is not clear.

The Quran has used “صَوْتُ” (*saut*) to mean evil forces (17:63). It means all sorts of wrong propaganda. It is also used to mean a man's voice (31:19), and also for a donkey's sound (31:19) where it is called “أَنْكَرَ الْأَصْوَاتِ” (*ankaral aswaat*).

Surah *Al-Hijrah* says:

49:2	do not raise your voice above that of the Messenger	لَا تَرْفَعُوا أَصْوَاتَكُمْ فَوْقَ صَوْتِ النَّبِيِّ
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If the real meaning of “صَوْتُ” (*saut*) is taken here, then it would pertain to courtesy. If symbolic meanings are taken, then it would mean to not to superimpose your decision over that of the Messengers. To give your suggestions but obey his decision (4:65, 33:36).

Sd-W-R ص و ر

“الصُّورَةُ” (*as-surah*): form, shape, the truth of anything or the reality of anything, trait, kind, features that make a man distinct from others or is recognizable (82:8) {T, M, R}.

“صَوَّرَ” (*sawwar*): to create a face (3:5).

“الْمُصَوِّرُ” (*al-musawwir*): the one who creates a face. It is Allah's attribute. Nothing can physically exist without some form. In Allah's creative program artistry is the stage where meta-physical forces are given a physical form or shape.

“صُورَةٌ” (*surah*) also has the plural as “صَوَرٌ” (*sawar*), as well as “صُورٌ” (*soor*) {T, M, R}. As such, where the Quran says “نُفِخَ صُورٌ” (*nafkhia fis soor*) in (78:18), it would mean when the *rooh* would be blown into the forms {T, M, R}, or when according to Allah's laws, new life would awaken among the nations (renaissance), or a new life in this world as well as a new life in the hereafter.

“صُورٌ” (*soor*) also means a trumpet which used to be blown at times of war, which heralds war {T, M, R}. With this meaning in mind, “نُفِخَ فِي الصُّورِ” (*nufikha fis soor*) in (69:13) means when the trumpet will be sounded for the battle of Allah's laws against evil forces.

“صَارَ الشَّيْءُ يَصُورُ” (*sarash shaiyah yasoorah*): to make a thing lean towards something, or to make something lean to one side.

“صُورَ يَصُورُ” (*saura yaswar*): to be attracted.

“صُرْتُ إِلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*surtu ilash shayi*): was attracted to that thing.

“صُرُّوا لِي” (*suraali*): attended to me.

“عُصْفُورٌ صَوَّارٌ” (*usfur sawwar*) means a bird which comes at calling.

“الصَّيَّوَارُ” (*as-siwaar*) means a herd of cattle (which follows the shepherd’s call).

In surah *Al-Baqrah*, *Ibrahim* is told:

2:260	familiarize these birds with yourself, make them your pets, make them so familiar that they come to you when called	فَخُذْ أَرْبَعَةً مِنَ الطَّيْرِ فَصُرْهُنَّ إِلَيْكَ
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Ibn Faris, after relating all these meanings, says that the root has so vastly different meanings that guess work is not possible (to determine their meanings).

Sd-W-Ain ص و ع

“الصَّاعُ” (*as-saa’u*), “الصَّوَّاعُ” (*asiw-wa’u*), “الصُّوَّاعُ” (*as-suwa’u*) is a measurement pot for measuring grain. Some say it does not measure grain but is a vessel which is used for drinking.

The Quran says “صُوعَ الْمَلِكِ” (*suwa al milk*) in (12:72), i.e. “a golden goblet” which was also used for filling water.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to be torn asunder and to part.

Sd-W-F ص و ف

“الصُّوفُ” (*as-soof*) with its plural form “أَصْوَافُ” (*aswaaf*) means wool (16:80).

“صُوفٌ” (*soof*): means sheep wool.

“شَعْرٌ” (*saha’ar*): goat’s wool.

“وَبَرٌ” (*wabar*): camel’s wool.

Surah *An-Nahal* mentions all three in (16:80). Some think that “الصُّوفِيُّ” (*as-sufi*) has a reference to “صُوفٌ” (*suuf*). The word “صُوفِيٌّ” (*sufi*) has appeared nowhere in the Quran. The very concept of *sufi-ism* is non-Quranic and borrowed from others. For details, see the book titled “*Letters to Salim*” vol. III).

Sd-W-M ص و م

“صَامٌ” (*saam*): to stop, to abstain, to be prevented.

“صَامَ عَنِ الْكَلَامِ” (*saama unil kalaam*): stopped talking, kept quiet.

“صَامَ عَنِ النِّكَاحِ” (*saama unin nikaah*): abstained from wedlock, or other contract.

“صَامَ عَنِ السَّيْرِ” (*saama unis sair*): stopped walking.

“صَامَ الْمَاءُ” (*saamul ma-u*): water became stagnant.

“مَصَامٌ” (*masamun*): the place to stand {T}.

The Quran has termed “صِيَامٌ” (*siyaam*) as compulsory (2:183). It means to abstain from morning till night from eating, drinking or having sex (2:187). These are the days of fasting during the month of Ramadan in which the Quran started being revealed. A man who is a resident (not traveling), and healthy (not sick) and his physique is such that fasting does not make him suffer, then “صِيَامٌ” (*siyaam*) is a must for him (2:184). A traveler after a journey and the sick after being healthy must complete the count of the days of fasting (2:184), but he who suffers during fasting should instead feed a needy (2:184).

Fasting is actually a sort of military training for making the **momineen** capable of bearing the difficulties of **jihad**, which is the struggle for establishing Allah's way of life.

The Quran has itself said:

2:183	So that you become capable of looking after the laws of Allah	لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَّقُونَ
2:185	so that you can establish the laws of Allah as given in the Quran and replace the system based on man made laws	لِتَكْبِرُوا اللَّهَ عَلَى مَا هَذَاكُمْ
2:185	so that your efforts can produce full results	وَلَعَلَّكُمْ تَشْكُرُونَ

“صَائِمٌ” (*saa'imun*): one who abstains from the wrong path, or one who fasts (33:35), or one who controls himself, and one who stays within the limits defined by the Quran. The Quran explains the purpose of its injunctions and in the case of fasting it declares that the purpose is to become righteous as defined in the Quran e.g. (2:183, 2:177, 23:1-9, 17:31-39). At an individual level one should assess the level of self-development on the first of Ramadan and then assess that after completion of the training through fasting what improvements have been made in the personality. The Quran recognises the difficulty of keeping fast and emphasises its importance through the effects it will have on the character development. Therefore it is important to understand the reason behind this value to get maximum benefit and not to follow it as a mere ritual as the latter will not contribute to any improvement despite fasting and remaining hungry/thirsty will result in no self-development.

Sd-Y-H

ص ي ح

“الصَّيْحَةُ” (*as-saiha*): a harsh sound emitted with full force.

“صَاحَ يَصِيحُ” (*saaha yaseehu*): to scream, make a high sound.

“صِيحَ بِهِمْ” (*seeha bihim*): they all were perturbed.

“صِيحَ فِيهِمْ” (*seeha fihim*): they were all killed.

“الصَّيْحَةُ” (*as-saiha*): looting when it occurs (when it is done against) on a tribe suddenly {T}.

Raghib says that “صَيَحَ” (*saih*) actually means to split the sound leading to screaming.

“إِنْصَاحَ الْخَشَبِ أَوِ النَّوْبِ” (*insaahal khashabu awais saub*): wood or cloth split, and made a sound {R}

“الصَّاعَةُ” (*as-sa'ihah*): to wail {T}.

The Quran has used “الصَّاعَةُ” (*as-sa'ihah*) to mean destruction, or the sound which is heard during an earthquake, or the rumble when a volcano erupts.

Surah **Hoodh** says “الصَّيْحَةُ” (*as-sa'ihah*) in (11:67). In surah **Al-Airaaf** the same thing has been called “الرَّجْفَةُ” (*ar-rajfah*) or earthquake ().

In surah **Yasin**, this word has been used for sudden destruction (36:29), because at such times there is associated shouting and crying caused by destruction.

“صَادَ” (*saadah*), “يَصِيدُهُ” (*yaseduhu*) and “يَصَادُ” (*yasaadu*) or “اِصْطَادَ” (*istadah*): to entrap somebody through a trap, scheme or ruse, to hunt.

“الصَّيْدُ” (*as-saeed*): to hunt down. It is used for all beasts whether hunted or not, and also for an animal which has been hunted down {*T, M*}.

The Quran has used “صَيْدُ الْبَحْرِ” (*sayd-ul-bahr*) and “صَيْدُ الْبَرِّ” (*sayd-ul-barr*) in (5:96), which means *saeed* of ocean and *saeed* of land. In Yemeni language, “الصَّيْدُ” (*as-saeed*) means fish {*T, M*}.

Muheet says “صَيْدٌ” (*saeed*) are things which look after themselves and which have no owner.

Raghib says “صَيْدٌ” (*saeed*) means entrapping animals which look after themselves and which are not owned by anybody {*T, M*}.

“صِيدْنَا مَاءَ السَّمَاءِ” (*sidna ma as samaa'a*): we drank rain water {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says that it means for a thing to go straight without dithering here or there.

A wild animal is also called “صَيْدٌ” (*saeed*) because it does not look here or there but keeps on running straight.

Ibn Faris says it means a place to return to, or to result in.

“صَارَ” (*saar*): for something to reach some state, or to reach a certain stage. It means for something to attain a certain form.

“الْمَصِيرُ” (*al-maiser*) is the point where waters from all sides meet, that is, a gathering place {*T*}

“الصَّيْرُ” (*as-sair*): the end result. This is also the meaning of “الصَّيُورُ” (*al-sayoor*).

“مَصِيرُ الْأَمْرِ” (*maseerul amr*): the result of an affair or matter, or the last destination of something.

“صَارَهُ” (*sarah*), “يَصِيرُهُ” (*yaseerah*): means to detach or cut something off {*T*}.

Raghib says “صَارَ” (*saar*) means to change from one state to another. This leads to “الْمَصِيرُ” (*al-maseer*) meaning a place where a thing reaches or results in, after a change or move.

The Quran says:

3:27	the human self-development can only be achieved by traversing the path that leads to Allah	إِلَى اللَّهِ الْمَصِيرُ
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The ultimate objective of an individual should be to adopt the attributes of Allah as explained and modelled in the Quran. This is what the Quran invites us to follow by using our intellect and reasoning. Anyother path will never lead to the type of self-development which the Quran has projected and is called as “بَيْتُ الْمَصِيرِ” (*be'sal maser*) (2:126) i.e. very bad destination. This state of human personality is termed as *jahannam*, i.e. if the option offered by the Quran is rejected then one essentially rejects the process which helps the self-development. This means that the self will not benefit from the Divine Attributes. To live a life within the permanent values of the Quran and to reflect His Attributes is what is termed by the Quran as “إِلَى اللَّهِ الْمَصِيرُ” (*ilallaahil msaseer*) – going in the direction of Allah.

About this surah *Ash-Shoorah* says:

42:53	All matters are ultimately decided as per Allah's Will (in accordance with Allah's laws):	إِلَى اللَّهِ تَصِيرُ الْأُمُورُ
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Those in heaven are said to be:

25:15	heaven is the place of the rewards of their (good) deeds and the place where their personality will be completed	كَانَتْ لَهُمْ جَزَاءٌ وَ مَصِيرًا
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This is the purpose of human creation i.e. to provide them opportunity to use their free will and adopt the path defined within the permanent values (19:10, 45:21).

Sd-Y-Sd

ص ي ص

“الصَّيِّصَةُ” (*as-saisatu*) and “الصَّيِّصَةُ” (*as-saisatu*): the horns of a cow and deer with which they defend themselves. This led to the meaning of “صَيْصِيَّةٌ” (*saisiyah*) as to that which is used by man to defend himself, for instance, a sanctuary, and a fort. The plural is “الصَّيَّاصِي” (*as-siyaasihi*).

The Quran says:

33:26	from their forts, in which they defend themselves	صَبَاطِصِهِمْ
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Sd-Y-F

ص ي ف

“الصَّيْفُ” (*as-sayf*): the summer season {*T, R*}. It is the opposite of “شِتَاءٌ” (*shitaa*) or winter season. For details see heading (Sh-T-W). The Quran has used “رِحْلَةَ الشَّتَاءِ وَ الصَّيْفِ” (*rihlatash shitai was saif*) in (106:2), that is, the journeys of the Quresh tribe for business during winter and summer.

Ibn Faris says this root has two basic meanings. It means period and summer, as well as to bow and move away.

“صَافٍ عَنِ الْهَدَفِ” (*saafa unil hadaf*) means that an arrow hit one side of the target, or deviated a little from the middle of the target.

“يَوْمٌ صَاعِفٌ” (*yaumun saa-if*): hot day.

“ضَائِنٌ” (*zaa-inn*) with its plural form “ضَائِنٌ” (*zaan*) means a sheep as used in (6:143). It also means weak. An old man is also called “ضَائِنٌ” (*zaa-in*) {T}. It means to be like a timid, chicken hearted, i.e. lacking courage.

“ضَبَحَتِ الْخَيْلُ ضَبْحًا” (*zabahatil khailu zabha*): the fast moving horses panted.

Abu Abeeadah says that “ضَبْحٌ” (*zabhun*) or “ضَبْعٌ” (*zab-un*) is used for a horse to run at full stretch so that it seems that his legs have come in line with his body, that is, to gallop.

Sahili says that “ضَبْحٌ” (*zabha*) means the panting sound of a camel or horse after it has run and become tired {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings. One is of sound, while the second is to change color due to the heat of the fire. He also claims that it originally was “ضَبْعٌ” (*zaa'a*), the meaning of which has appeared above.

The Quran says:

100:1	fast horses used in battle	وَالْغُلَاقِ ضَبْحًا
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“ضَجَّعَ” (*zaba'a*), and “أَضْطَجَّعَ” (*as taja*): he put his side on the ground, i.e. he lied down. “الْمُضْطَجَّعُ” (*al-muztaja*): a place to lie down {T}. The same meaning goes for “الْمُضْجَعُ” (*al-mazja*). The plural is “الْمُضْجَعُ” (*mazaji-ah*) as in (32:16).

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:153	their places of slaughter (or murder)	مُضْجَعِهِمْ
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That is, the place where the corpse is laid after killing.

“الْمُضْجَعَةُ” (*almuzaja-ah*) also means intercourse {T}.

Surah *An-Nisaa* says:

4:34	Cut off marital relations within a wedlock.	وَأُخْرِجُوهُنَّ فِي الْمُضْجَعِ
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“ضَحِكَ” (*zahika*), “يُضْحَكُ” (*yuzha*), “ضَحْكًا” (*zahka*): cheerful face with pleasure, and to grin due to happiness, to laugh.

“ضَحْكٌ” (*zahk*): laughter. The first step is to smile.

“ضَحِكٌ” (*zahika*) also means to laugh in surprise {T}.

“ضَحِكَ الرَّجُلُ” (*zahikar rajul*): he was surprised {M}

Ibn Faris says it basically means to flower and to expose.

Surah *At-Tauba* says:

9:82	Let them laugh a little (celebrate a little)	فَلْيُضْحِكُوا قَلِيلًا
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As against it is:

9:82	should cry a lot	وَأَبْكُوا كَثِيرًا
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“صَاحِكًا” (*zaahika*): being happy (27:19).

Surah *At-Tatfeef* says:

83:29	they used to laugh at the Believers	كَانُوا مِنَ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا يَضْحَكُونَ
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“إِمْرَأَةً صَاحِكَةً” (*imra-atun zaahika*): the woman who is having her periods {M}.

Surah *Hoodh* says “فَضَحِكَتْ” (*fazahikat*) in regard to when *Ibrahim*’s wife got the news about the birth of a son (11:71).

Some say it means that she started menstruating {T}, and this showed that she could still bear a child.

Raghib says this is not the right meaning, and it means to relate to *Ibrahim*’s wife’s condition.

The truth is that out of surprise she had laughed. The next verse supports this meaning where it is said:

11:73	Do you wonder on Allah’s decree?	أَتَعْجَبُونَ مِنْ أَمْرِ اللَّهِ
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People have most likely thought of menstruation because of verse (21:90) where it is said:

21:90	For him We cured his wife	وَأَضْلَحْنَا لَهُ زَوْجَهُ
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Often the problem of infertility that needs to be cured is the absence of periods. That is why whatever word that appeared in this context, got translated to mean periods and this use is not right in the context in which this is mentioned in these verses.

Zd-H-W/Y

ض ح و/ي

“الضُّحَى” (*az-zahwu*), “الضَّحْوَةُ” (*az-zahwah*), “الضَّحِيَّةُ” (*az-zahiyyah*), “الضُّحَى” (*az-zuha*): the time when the day progresses (has dawned fully), or the time after sunrise. Some think that it means the time from sunrise till the day has fully dawned {T}.

Raghib says “الضُّحَى” (*az-zuha*) means for sunrise to spread everywhere and for the day to fully dawn. This time is also termed “الضُّحَى” (*az-zuha*).

“الضَّحَاءُ” (*az-zahaa*) is the time before half of the day, or when the sun is at a quarter of its height in the sky.

Ibn Faris says it means for sunrise to spread everywhere and for everything to be bright and visible.

79:30	And brought out its light (made the day bright)	وَأَخْرَجَ ضُحَاهَا
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“ضَحَى” (*zuhia*): for sunrise to engulf everything, to come out in sunlight, to be pained by sunlight and its heat.

“وَلَا تُضْحَى” (*wala tuzha*): will not be troubled by sunlight and its heat (20:119).

“فَعَلَهُ صَاحِيَةً” (*fa’alahu zaahiya*): he did it openly.

“صَحَا الطَّرِيقُ صُحُوءًا” (*zahat tareequ zuhuwa*): road became evident and clear {T}.

“لَيْلَةٌ صَحِيَاءُ” (*lailatun zahya*): illuminated night when there are no clouds and the moonlight remains from beginning to end {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means for something to be evident and clear.

“الضِدُّ” (*az-zid*): opposite, which cannot be present at the same time, as blackness and whiteness, life and death. “ضِدًّا” (*az-zidd*): opponent.
 “الْقَوْمُ عَلَيْهِ ضِدٌّ وَاحِدٌ” (*al-qoumu ilaihin ziddun wahid*): the people banded together in opposing him.
 “هُمَا مُتَضَادَّانِ” (*huma mutazaddaan*): they are opposite to each other {T, M, R}.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:82	they will be their opponents	وَيَكُونُونَ عَلَيْهِمْ ضِدًّا
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“ضَرْبٌ” (*zarb*) has a lot of meanings. Famous among these is to hit or strike.

Ibn Faris says it also means to mold.

“الضَّرْبُ” (*az-zarbu*) and “الزَّرْبُ” (*az-zirbu*) means to be alike or similar, because one thing is molded into the other's form.

36:13	relate an example to them (make this thing more explicit to them through an example)	وَاضْرِبْ لَهُمْ مَثَلًا
13:17	Allah explains falsehood and truth through an example	يَضْرِبُ اللَّهُ الْحَقَّ وَالْبَاطِلَ

It may also mean to clash with each other.

“ضَرَبَ الطَّيْرُ” (*zarabit tair*): the birds flew away in search of food.
 “ضَرَبَ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*zarabna fil ard*) is said when someone goes on a journey in search of a livelihood.
 “اضْرَبَ الرَّجُلُ فِي الْبَيْتِ” (*azrabar rajulu fil beit*) means that a man stayed at home.
 “ضَرَبَ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ” (*zaraba unish shaiyi*): he abstained from that thing, avoided it. This is also the meaning of “اضْرَبَ عَنْهُ” (*azraba unhu*).
 “ضَرَبَ عَنْهُ الذِّكْرَ وَاضْرَبَ عَنْهُ” (*zaraba unhuz zikra wa azrib unhu*): turned him from the mention and removed him, stopped him.
 Modern dictionary says “اضْرَابٌ” (*izraab*) means “to strike”.
 “ضَرَبْنَا عَلَى آذَانِهِمْ” (*zarabna ala aazaanihim*): we prevented them from hearing the voice.
 “ضَرَبَ إِلَيْهِ” (*zaraba ilaih*): he was attracted towards him.
 “اضْطَرَبَ” (*iztarab*) means for a part of something to strike a part of another. It also means to acquire and to earn.
 “اضْطَرَبَ امْرُؤٌ” (*iztarabas amruhu*): his matter was spoiled {T, M, L}.
 “مُضْطَرِبٌ” (*muztarib*): mobile, moving {T, M, L}.

The Quran says:

8:12	to strike	فَاضْرِبُوا فَوْقَ الْأَغْنَانِ
2:61	to hit with ignominy and insult	ضَرَبَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ الدَّلَّةُ وَالْمَسْكَنَةُ
4:101	to travel	إِذَا ضَرَبْتُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ
16:74	do not equate anyone with God (Do not create mental concepts about Him whether He is like so and so etc.)	وَلَا تُضْرِبُوا لِلَّهِ الْأَمْثَالَ
43:5	Will we stop the code of life from you (being applied to you)?	أَفَنَضْرِبُ عَنْكُمْ الذِّكْرَ

Will we not implement the laws of the Quran in your case? And permit you to do whatever you wish and follow whatever path you deem fit? This will not happen!

“ضَرَبَ مَثَلًا” (*zaraba masalan*) means to explain a thing through an example. At some places only “ضَرَبَ” (*zaraba*) has this meaning.

13:17	Allah explains <i>haq (truth)</i> and <i>baatil(evil)</i> in this manner, (or makes one understand)	كَذَٰلِكَ يَضْرِبُ اللَّهُ الْحَقَّ وَالْبَاطِلَ
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It also means the struggle between *haqq* (truth) and *baatil* (evil).

The Quran says:

43:58	these people do not want to make a point but only desire to pick a quarrel	مَا ضَرَبُوهُ لَكَ إِلَّا جَدَلًا
4:34	with different examples explain to them	وَاضْرِبُوهُنَّ

As such, “وَاضْرِبُوا لَهُنَّ مَثَلًا” (*wazribu hunna maslan*) is that corporal punishment which is awarded by a court, for women to abstain from their natural duties (like giving birth to children) and acting like a man (as it is happening in Europe). This is a social crime which must be punished through the courts and be stopped.

In surah *Taha* and other places, *Moosa* has been told:

20:77	take them through the dry road in the sea	فَاضْرِبْ لَهُم مَّصَرَفًا فِي الْبَحْرِ يَبَسًا
26:63 44:24	take your group across the sea (or by using the staff walk along)	اضْرِبْ بِعَصَاكَ الْبَحْرَ

At another place it is said:

7:165	Take your group towards the mountain, they will find springs of water there to drink from. (Strike your staff on the rock, this will split the stones or the ground and water will spring forth.)	اضْرِبْ بِعَصَاكَ الْحَجَرَ
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Zd-R-R ض ر ر

“ضَرَّ” (*zarr*), “يَضُرُّ” (*yazurr*): to harm
 “الضَّرُّ” (*az-zarr*), “الضَّرُّ” (*az-zurr*): loss. It is usually used for financial loss or external illness.
 “الضَّرُّ” (*az-zurr*): the misfortune or loss which is related to human Self.
 “الضَّرُّ” (*az-zurr*): famine, intensity of loss, adverse situation.
 “الضَّرَاءُ” (*az-zarra'a*): to be disbale, to be lame. It also means poverty, deprivation and ill-fortune.
 “الضَّرِيرُ” (*az-zareer*): blind, sick, weak, ill-fated {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says “الضَّرِيرُ” (*az-zareer*) means patience and a strong will power.

“الضَّرَرُ” (*az-zarar*): lack of subsistence .
 “الضَّرُورَةُ” (*az-zarurah*): need.
 “الْإِضْطِرَارُ” (*al-izтираar*): to be compelled by need {T, M}.
 “الضَّرَّتَانِ” (*az-zartaan*): two stones of a grindstone, the two wives of a man.
 “الْإِضْرَارُ” (*al-izraar*): to marry another woman while one is already married.
 “تَزَوَّجْتُ الْمَرْأَةَ عَلَى ضِرٍّ” (*tazawwajtul mar'a ala zirr*): I married that woman while I had a wife. This shows that the Arabs too were aware of the complications and difficulties of having two wives.
 “الْمُضِيرُ” (*al-muzirr*): the one who becomes close {T, M}.

This word has appeared in (2:102) against profit or “نَفْعٌ” (*naft'a*), against “خَيْرٌ” (*khairun*) in (6:17) and in (16:53), and to mean corporal pain in (21:83). In (2:174) it is said “اضْطُرَّ” (*uztur*) which means involuntary condition.

The Quran says:

2:282	the writer must suffer no harm	وَلَا يُضَارُّ كَاتِبٌ
4:95	those who will have no corporal pain(sickness)	غَيْرَ أُولَى الضَّرَرِ
9:107	imparting mutual loss	ضِرَارًا
4:12	which does harm each other	غَيْرُ مُضَارٍّ
2:126	I will render them helpless and take them towards the punishment of fire	ثُمَّ اضْطَرْكُ إِلَى عَذَابِ النَّارِ
2:174	he who becomes helpless	فَمَنْ اضْطُرَّ
27:65	helpless	مُضْطَرَّ

Zd-R-Ain ض ر ع

“الضَّرْعُ” (*az-zar’a*): the teats of cows, goats, etc.: a she-camel’s teats are called “خِلْفٌ” (*khilf*) {T}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is softness.

The teats are said to be “ضَرْعٌ” (*zar-un*) because of their softness.

“ضَرَعُ الْبَهِيمِ” (*zara-ul bahmu*) means the progeny of the four legged animals put their mouths to their mothers’ teats {L}. This can make one understand the meaning of “تَضَرَّعَ إِلَى اللَّهِ” (*tazarr’u ilal-laah*), i.e. to approach the real source of nourishment for own sustenance.

7:55	refer to Allah’s law of nourishment for your development	ادْعُوا رَبَّكُمْ تَضَرُّعًا وَخُفْيَةً
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For more details of this meaning, see also under the heading (Ain-W-D) the word “تَعَوَّذُ” (*ta-awwuz*).

Further ahead it is said:

7:55	He does not like rebels who transgress the limits	إِنَّهُ لَا يُحِبُّ الْمُعْتَدِينَ
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It is obvious from above that the term “تَضَرَّعًا” (*tazarru’a*) has the basic element of obedience to Allah as revealed in the Quran.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:42	When (due to their deeds) according to the law of requital , results became evident to them, why did they not accept the obedience Our laws?	لَوْلَا إِدْخَاءُ هُمْ بِأَسْنَا تَضَرَّعُوا
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“الضَّرْعُ” (*az-zareeh*) is a sort of cactus that grows in *Hijaaz*. The four legged animals do not even go near it (for grazing). It makes one weak if it is eaten. This word also means a smelly grass that grows in stagnant water which animals do not feed on {T}. Sometimes the sea throws out such sort of plantation on the beaches and any animal which eats it, becomes weak {L}.

Surah *Al-Ghashia* calls the food of the hell dwellers as “ضَرْعٌ” (*zareeh*) in (88:6), i.e. the food which is discarded by others. It is food that depresses human potentials instead of serving as a nourishment. At a community level only weak and enslaved nations get this sort of sustenance. With regards to stopping development, see *jaheem* in heading (J-He-M).

“الضَّرْعُ” (*az-zari’u*) and “الضَّرْعُ” (*az-zari’u*) means every weak and feeble thing {T}.

“ضَرَعُ لَه” (*zari’a lahu*) and “ضَرَعُ” (*zara’a*): asked him for something and at the same time described one’s own pitiful condition.

“الضَّرْعُ” (*az-zuruh*): to become feeble.

“مَالَهُ زَرْعٌ” (*ma lahu zar-un*) and “لَا ضَرْعُ” (*la zar-un*): he has nothing {T}.

“أَضْرَعَ لِفُلَانٍ مَالًا” (*azra’a li fulanin ma’la*): he spent all his money {M}.

However, “تَضَرُّعًا” (*tazarru awn*) means for man to look or go towards Allah for sustenance in order to develop, and obey His laws with his strong belief and willingness. If he does not do this, then he will get “ضَرِيْعٌ” (*zaree'un*) to eat. That is, the ignominious food which results in moral and material deprivation thus suppressing the value as a human being.

Zd-Ain-F ض ع ف

“الضَّعْفُ” (*az-za'af*), “الضُّعْفُ” (*az-zoaf*), “الضَّعْفُ” (*az-za'afa*): weakness {T}.

Muheet says that “ضَعْفٌ” (*za'af*) means weakness of an expressed opinion, and “ضُعْفٌ” (*zo'af*) means physical weakness.

Surah *Ar-Rom* has used “قُوَّةٌ” (*zo'af*) against strength in (30:54)

Surah *Al-Anfal* has used “ضَعْفٌ” (*za'af*) to mean military weakness.

Surah *Ibrahim* has used “ضَعْفٌ” (*zo'afa*) against “مُسْتَكْبِرِينَ” (*mustakbireena*) in (10:21).

“ضِعَافٌ” (*zi'aaf*) is the singular of “ضَعِيفٌ” (*za-eef*) and means weak (2:28). Here this word has been used to mean overwhelmed by emotions.

“إِسْتَضْعَفَهُ” (*iztas'afahu*): considered him to be weak, lowly (7:150).

“مُسْتَضْعَفٌ” (*mustaz'af*): he who is considered weak (4:75). It is obvious that the weak have their rights usurped and other undue advantages also taken of their weakness i.e. their weakness is exploited due to their being poor.

Ibn Faris says it has two different meanings. One is of weakness, while the second meaning is of doubling something up.

“ضِعْفٌ” (*zi'foon*) is the singular of “أَضْعَافٌ” (*az-aaf*) and means for something to be similar to another. It also means equal share, more of such. This way the thing is doubled. Some think it means even three times or four times more, not just double. It is also used to mean unlimited in quantity {T}.

The Quran says:

2:245	several times more	فَيَضْعَفُ لَهُ أَضْعَافًا كَثِيرَةً
7:38	double	ضِعْفٌ
2:265	Double	فِعْفَيْنِ
3:129	do not gain interest after interest	لَا تَأْكُلُوا الرِّبَا أَضْعَافًا مُضَاعَفَةً

Raghib says “مُضَاعَفَةً” (*muza'afah*) in (3:129) actually is from “ضَعِيفٌ” (*za'eef*) not from “ضِعْفٌ” (*ziif*). Therefore this verse is referring to interest “رِبَاٌ” (*riba*) which you think increases the money, but in fact decreases it. Interest decreases a society's wealth and the man who gives money on interest loses his capabilities. With “رِبَاٌ” (*riba*) national wealth decreases and weakness upon weakness is created.

“ضَغَتِ الْحَدِيثُ” (*za-asal hades*): to make a matter distorted or ambiguous.

“الضَّغْتُ” (*zaghsu*): intermingling of things.

“ضَغَتِ السَّائِمُ” (*saghas sinaam*): when it is difficult to say whether the camel is fat or lean, and one has to see physically by holding the hump in the hand whether it has some fat or not.

Therefore ambiguous talk is called “كَلَامٌ ضِغْتُ” (*kalaamun zighsun*) {*T, M, R*}. Plural is “أَضْغَاتٌ” (*az-ghaas*).

The Quran says:

12:44	dreams which have no clear meaning, disturbing dreams	أَضْغَاتُ أَحْلَامٍ
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“ضِغْتُ” (*zighsun*): a fistful of grass, bouquet or branches, a fistful of something {*T, M, R*}.

Surah *Saad* says in the narrative about *Ayub*:

38:44	take a fistful of grass	خُذْ بِيَدِكَ ضِغْتًا
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Ibn Faris says “الضَّغْتُ” (*az-zighsu*) means a fistful of branches or straws. In ancient medicine, and today too, many diseases are treated with herbs and leaves of trees.

Lissanul Arab says it also means a little benefit of this world, a handful.

Ibn Faris says that the root basically means to cover some facts under false pretense.

“الضَّغْنُ” (*az zighn*): extreme enmity: extreme prejudice, extreme dislike.

“ضَغْنَ عَلَيْهِ” (*zaaghan ilaih*): he held extreme prejudice against him: held extreme enmity.

“فَرَسٌ ضَاغِنٌ” (*farasa zaaghinu*): means a horse which does not trot without being struck.

“اِصْطَفَنَ” (*istaghanah*): he hid some thing under his arm: or took it in his lap {*T, M, R*}.

“قَنَآةٌ ضِغْنَةٌ” (*qanatun zaaghinah*): crooked or bent spear. Crooked (evil) and covered.

The Quran says:

47:37 47:29	Allah will expose their prejudices and enmity (i.e. which they are hiding and reveal their conspiracies).	يُخْرِجُ اللَّهُ أَضْغَانَهُمْ
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“الضَّفْدُ” (*az-zifdah*), “الضَّفْدُ” (*az-zafdah*): frog {*T*}.

Plural is “ضَفَادِيحُ” (*zafadih*) as in (7:133).

“الضَّلَّةُ” (*az-zallah*): surprise, to be surprised, to wander in search of, perplexed, confused, for something to be hidden and disappear, for different things to be so mixed up that they cannot be separated from each other.

“ضَلَّ الْمَاءُ فِي اللَّيْنِ” (*zall al-ma'u fil laban*): a few drops of water got mixed with milk and thus disappeared. It is also used not be able to think of any argument or reason, or to forget and to lose memory {*Ibn Qateebah*}.

“ضَلَّالَةٌ” (*zalaalah*): to move away from the right path, whether intentionally or inadvertently, a little or very much. Since one who loses his way in the desert does not find his destination despite all efforts, therefore for all efforts to fail are also called “ضَلَّ سَعْيُهُ” (*zalla saa yah*). Since wandering in this way in the desert means destruction and annihilation at last, this word is also used in these meanings {L}. It also means to be wasted, to be fruitless.

“نَهَبَ نَمُّهُ ضِلَّةً” (*zahaba zumuu zillah*): his blood was wasted for nothing, because no compensation or revenge could be taken {T}.

“الضَّلَالُ” (*az-zalal*): the water which is under a rock or the shade of a tree, and is safe from sunlight.

“ضَلَّانِي فُلَانٌ” (*zallani fulanun*): he went out of my control and I had no power over him {T}.

“الْمُضِلُّ” (*al-mazallu*), “الْمُضِلُّ” (*al-muzillu*): mirage which in the desert sand, shimmers like water {T}.

When the Messenger **Muhammed** was thinking and making effort in search of the Truth, that is, before the revelation of the Quran, the Quran has described that condition as “وَوَجَدَكَ ضَالًّا” (*wawajadaka dalla*) in (93:7). A messenger-to-be, even before the messenger-hood, is unhappy and dissatisfied with the prevalent wrong concepts and beliefs around him of life. Since the true concepts have not yet been revealed to him, therefore he makes effort and struggles in search of the truth. Then he gets guidance from God as a revelation, and this effort succeeds and he gets a new direction within the Divine Guidance.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** uses “ضَلَّالَةٌ” (*zalaalah*) against guidance in (2:16). In surah **Ibrahim**, for deeds to remain without result and efforts to be unsuccessful, is said to be “ضَلَّالٌ” (*zalaal*).

Surah **Al-Kahaf** has “ضَلَّ سَعْيُهُمْ” (*zalla sa'yuhim*) in (18:104). In surah **Ibrahim**, by using this word opposite to stability, it has been shown that this word means destruction and annihilation (14:27). In surah **Al-Hijr**, the result of “ضَلَّالَتٌ” (*zalat*) has been described as hopelessness and the deprivation from Allah's benevolence (15:56).

Surah **Al-A'raf** has “ضَلُّوا عَنَّا” (*zallu unna*) in (7:37), which means that they were lost to us or disappeared. In surah **As-sajdah** where this saying of the deniers has been quoted “إِذَا ضَلَلْنَا فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*iza zalalna fil ard*) in (32:10), it means that “will we after being wasted and turned to dust”.

“تَضْلِيلٌ” (*tazlilun*) means to waste, to make unsuccessful, to divert and to put on the wrong path (105:2).

As such, “ضَالِّينَ” (*zawalleen*) would refer to those who instead of seeking guidance from the revelation, pursue their own desires and base pleasures and thus loose direction in life just like a traveler who is lost in a barren desert. He wanders the whole day but the destination eludes him. Thus all his efforts are wasted and as a result he is dead despite making efforts to find the right direction and never reaches his destination. As against this are the “مُنْعَمٌ عَلَيْهِ” (*mun'im ilaih*) (1:6), which are those whose condition is quite the opposite and who benefit from the righteous path.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says that in matters of business deals, two men should be taken as witnesses and if two men are not available, then one man and two women should be taken. Two women because:

2:282	If one of them mixes up some detail, then the other could remind her	أَنْ تَضِلَّ إِحْدَاهُمَا فَتُذَكِّرْ إِخْدَاهُمَا الْأُخْرَى
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This does not mean that she will forget, as is usually believed, but because a woman is more emotional and shy. She may under pressure of the situation (surrounded by men) get confused especially if there is a controversy. At another place in the Quran it is said:

43:18	She may not be able to be explicit, especially in a controversy in which emotions are certainly flying around	وَهُوَ فِي الْخِصَامِ غَيْرُ مُبِينٍ
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Refined emotions are necessary for a woman's biological compulsion as a mother where she is given the duty of bearing children. Therefore this is not a limitation or weakness. With proper education and training, she can retain these emotions, and be outspoken and articulate as well (56:37) as we can see all around us in the modern world where women are now found working in higher positions of responsibility. See heading (Ain-R-B).

Zd-M-R ض م ر

“الْضُّمُرُ” (*az-zumr*), “الْضُّمُرُ” (*az-zumur*): to be weak, for the stomach to become so lean as to be seemingly stuck to the back.

“ضَمَرَ الْفَرَسُ” (*zamaral fars*): for a horse to be very weak.

“قَضِيبُ ضَامِرٍ” (*qazeebun daamir*): a dried and shrunken branch of plant which has lost all freshness {T}.

The Quran says “عَلَى كُلِّ ضَامِرٍ” (*ala kulli daamir*) in (22:27) which means “on very weak and lean rides”.

Raghib says “الضَّامِرُ مِنَ الْفَرَسِ” (*ad daamiru minal faras*) means “the lean horse whose leanness is not due to weakness but due to tough training”.

“الضَّمِيرُ” (*az-zameer*): dried grape, or anything that you hide in your heart.

“أَضْمَرَهُ” (*azmarahu*): he hid him {T}.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings. One is leanness and fineness, and the second is for something to hide or be oblivious.

Zd-M-M ض م م

“الْضَّمُّ” (*az-zumm*): to join one thing with another or mix it with another.

“اِضْطَمَّ الشَّيْءُ” (*iztammash shaiyi*): collected something for himself.

“ضَمَمْتُهُ إِلَى صَدْرِي” (*zamamtuhu ila sadri*): I embraced him {T}.

“ضَمَّ عَلَى الْمَالِ” (*zamma alal maal*): he seized all the wealth {R}.

“ضَمَّ جَنَاحَكَ عَنِ النَّاسِ” (*zumma junahaka unin nas*): be kind to people and be courteous with them {T}

Ibn Faris says it means for two things to be in agreement.

Surah **Taha** has:

20:22	In the ensuing event do not be worried and stay calm and continue to relate the bright (or illuminating) principles as related to you through the revelation (Figurative meaning)	وَاضْمُمْ يَدَكَ إِلَى جَنَاحِكَ تَخْرُجَ بَيْضَاءَ مِنْ غَيْرِ سُوءٍ
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And surah **Al-Qasas** says:

28:32	Put your hand into your shirt, it will come out white without any bad effect, and keep your arms around you in fear. (Literal meaning)	أَسْلُكْ يَدَكَ فِي جَيْبِكَ تَخْرُجَ بَيْضَاءَ مِنْ غَيْرِ سُوءٍ وَاضْمُمْ إِلَيْكَ جَنَاحَكَ مِنَ الرَّهْبِ
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For the meaning of “يَدٌ بَيْضَاءُ” (*yadun baiza-un*), see heading (Y-D-Y). Also see (7:108), (26:33). For the meaning of “جَنَاحُ” (*janah*), see heading (J-N-H) along with (28:32).

Hence these verses mean that in fear, do not be worried, but remain calm, the way a bird sits with its feathers around it in a calm moment. You will come out of all difficulties. The enemy will not be able to do you any harm.

“الضَّنْكَ” (*az-zank*): narrow (i.e. not expanse).

“الضَّنِيكَ” (*az-zaneek*): a person who is weak in intellect, opinion or physically, etc. It also means a servant who only works for food.

“رَجُلٌ مُتَضَنِّكٌ” (*rajulun mutadaniun*): weak man {*T, M, R*}...

The Quran says that any individual or nation which will ignore the laws of Allah will:

20:124	their economies will be restricted and they will never have prosperity	فَإِنَّ لَهُ مَعِيشَةً ضَنْكًا
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Obviously the nations which are ignoring the laws of Allah, i.e. not abiding by them (today so called Muslims are in the forefront of such nations) are avoiding Allah's laws. This is evident and obvious example and leaves no room for doubt.

“ضَنَّ بِالشَّيْءِ يَضُنُّ” (*zanna bishaiyin yadann*): to be miserly with desired and favorite things.

“الضَّنِينُ” (*az-zaneen*): the man who is miserly with good things.

“الضَّنُّ” (*az-zinn*): the thing with which miserliness is practiced {*T*}, which is saved and preserved.

The Quran says about the messenger *Muhammed*:

81:24	Whatever he receives as revelation, he is not miserly with making it known to all. (he gives to anyone who wants it)	وَمَا هُوَ عَلَى الْعَيْبِ بِضَنِينٍ
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“الضَّهْيَاءُ” (*az-zahya*): a woman who can neither bear a child nor menstruate, or who has very small breasts and is flat chested. “ضَاهَاةٌ” (*zahahu*), “مُضَاهَاةٌ” (*muzahah*), “ضَاهَاةٌ” (*azahahu*), “مُضَاهَاةٌ” (*muzaaha'ah*): he became like, became similar to. “هُوَ ضَهِيكٌ” (*huwa zahiyo*): he resembles you {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says the word basically means for a thing to resemble another.

The Quran says:

9:30	They talk like those who before them adopted the path of denial. These are all of the same type.	يُضَاهَوْنَ قَوْلَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا مِنْ قَبْلُ
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“ضَوْءٌ” (*zau'un*) or “ضُوءٌ” (*zu'un*) means light, illumination, as also said under the heading (N-W-R).

“أَضَاءٌ” (*aza'a*) means to illuminate, or be illuminated.

Zamkhashri says that “ضَوْءٌ” (*zau-un*) is a stronger word than “نُورٌ” (*noor*), although both have the same meaning. “ضَوْءٌ” (*zau'u*) means somebody's personal light and “نُورٌ” (*noor*) means the light gained from someone else {*T*}. Probably this is why the sunlight has been called “ضَوْءٌ” (*zau-un*) while moonlight has been called “نُورٌ” (*noor*) as in (10:5) – i.e. the Sun has its own light while the moon has reflected light. But the Quran has used one word in place of another, as for example the Torah has in (5:44) been called “نُورٌ” (*noor*), and in (21:48) has been called “ضِيَاءٌ” (*zia*).

2:17	when it illuminated the environment	فَلَمَّا أَضَاءَتْ مَا حَوْلَهُ
24:35	its oil (is heated up) that it is near being alighted or illuminated	يَكَادُ زَيْتُهَا يَضِيءُ

“ضَارَ فُلَانًا حَقًّا” (*zaazan fulanun haqqahu*): he reduced his rights.

“قِسْمَةٌ ضَيْرَى” (*qismatun deeza*): that unjust distribution in which somebody is made to bear a loss, or a distribution which is not just.

“الضُّورَةُ” (*az-zuwaazah*): that fiber of a wooden branch, which was used for cleaning teeth and, is stuck into ones teeth {T, M}. Even such a small bit is oppressive and not right.

Ibn Faris says that this root's basic meanings are to be crooked, and to loss or decrease.

The Quran says:

53:22	this division then is a very unjust division	تِلْكَ إِذَا قِسْمَةٌ ضَيْرَى
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“الضَّيْرُ” (*az-zair*): means harm.

“ضَارَهُ” (*dara*) and “ضَرَّهُ” (*sarrah*) also mean to impart harm or loss or hurt someone {T}.

The Quran says:

26:50	There is no harm (there is nothing wrong with it).	لَا ضَيْرَ
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“ضَاعَ” (*zaa*), “يُضَيِّعُ” (*yazeeh*), “ضَيِّعًا” (*zai'a*): to be killed or wasted.

“ضَاعَ الشَّيْءُ” (*za'ash shamsi*): the thing was left as it was, and it was not looked after.

“ضَاعَ الْعِيَالُ” (*zaa'al ayaal*): the family was left untrained, and was not brought up properly, thus was left on its own.

“تَرَكْتُهُ بِضَيِّعٍ” (*taraktuhu bidee'ah*): I left him without looking after him

“الضِّيَاغُ” (*az-ziyah*) is the plural of “ضَاءٌ” (*zayah*) and means things which are not looked after and are thus wasted {T, M}.

“الضِّيْعَةُ” (*az-zai'ah*) also means property because if it is not kept open for the benefit of mankind, it ultimately gets wasted.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:143	Allah is not the one to leave your trust go unrewarded and not look after you and let you go wasted, and without producing any result	وَمَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيُضَيِّعَ إِيمَانَكُمْ
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Surah *Maryam* says that after the messengers, such people were born who:

19:59	did not care about the system of <i>salaat</i> and left it unattended and started pursuing their own desires	أَضَاعُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَاتَّبَعُوا الشَّهَوَاتِ
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“الضَّيْفُ” (*az-zaid*) means guest. It is both singular and plural {*T, M*}.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:78	Do not disgrace me concerning my quests	لَا تُخْزُونِي فِي ضَيْفِي
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Here “ضَيْفٌ” (*zeef*) has come to mean plural.

“صَافَ إِلَيْهِ” (*zaafa ilaih*): he leaned towards him, leaned towards, bent, and became close to.

“ضَيَّفَ” (*dayya-if*): to host, to make someone your guest {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:77	they refused to host them	فَأَبَوْا أَنْ يُضَيِّفُوهُمْ
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“الْمُضَافُ” (*almu-zaaf*): sanctuary, to make one incline to someone, lean forward, It also means when someone is encircled all around during a battle.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of the root is to lean and incline towards someone.

“صَاقَ” (*zaaq*), “يَضِيقُ” (*yazeeq*), “ضَيْقًا” (*zeeqan*): to be frustrated, to be bothered.

“ضَيِّقَ” (*zayyaq*): to bother.

“الضَّيِّقُ” (*az-zeequ*) and “الضَّيِّقُ” (*az-zaiq*): constriction. This is the opposite of “الشَّرْحُ” (*ush-sharh*).

Therefore, to comprehend its right meaning, see heading (Sh-R-H). These two roots have appeared opposite each other in (9:126).

“ضَيِّقَ” (*zayyiq*): narrow (6:126).

“ضَيِّقَ” (*zaiq*): constriction (16:127).

“ضَائِقَ” (*za'iq*): that which is constricted or narrow (11:12). The connotations of sorrow and sadness are found in them.

11:77	for their protection he found his ability and resources to be inadequate	صَاقَ بِهِمْ ذُرْعًا
9:118	the earth became narrow for them	صَاقَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ الْأَرْضُ
9:118	they became fed up of themselves	صَاقَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ أَنْفُسُهُمْ
65:6	do not bother them	وَلَا تُضَارُّوهُمْ لَنْ يُضِيقُوا عَلَيْهِمْ

Allah made **Taloot** the commander of the **Bani Israeli** forces that were going to meet **Jaloot's** (Goliath) challenge. He had knowledge as well as physical strength; since these two things are required in a commander. His appointment was opposed by the **Bani Israel** because they said that he was not of royal blood, i.e. he was not from among the aristocrats. To this Allah had replied that a commander's qualities are knowledge of warfare and strength, not wealth and riches (2:247)

Muheet says that it is a non-Arabic word. **Raghib** also supports this.

Ibn Faris says that “طَبَعَ” (**at-tab'u**) is used metaphorically for defining the extreme scale of a thing, e.g. a place where the thing can reach the farthest and ends there.

“طَبَعَ” (**taba'a**): for a glass to be filled to the brim.

“تَطَبَعَ النَّهْرُ” (**tattaba'an nahur**): river got filled.

“أَلْطَبَعَ” (**at-taba'a**) means to seal.

Abu Ishaq says that “طَبَعَ” (**tab'a**) and “خَتَمَ” (**khatam**) mean the same thing, i.e. to close something and cover it and to make certain that nothing else can be added to it.

“طَبَعْتُ الْمِخْيَالُ” (**taba'tul mikyaal**): I filled the cup to the brim and now nothing else can be added {T}.

Raghib says that “طَبَعَ” (**tab'a**) is more common than “خَتَمَ” (**khatam**) and more particular than “نَقَشَ” (**naqsh**).

“أَلْطَبَعَ” (**at-tabi'u**) and “الطَّبَعُ” (**at-tabi'u**) is used for the branding iron with which animals e.g. goats etc. are marked.

“الطَّبَاعَةُ” (**at-tiba'a**): moulding, printing.

“الطَّبَّاعُ” (**at-tabba'a**): Someone who does moulding work.

“الطَّبْعُ” (**at-tab'a**) is used for something which is moulded or made first.

The Quran says:

23:3	Their hearts were sealed, which resulted in their being unable to think right	فَطَبَعَ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ فَهُمْ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ
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Also see (2:7) and heading (Kh-T-M)

When an individual adopts a way of being biased and prejudiced then he loses the faculty of logical thinking which affects the decision making process. . This prevents him from considering the Quranic values rationally and using his intellect and reasoning to analyse the message. This is what has been described by the Quran as hearts and minds being sealed and it has been clearly stated that this happens due to man's own doings. In fact, this way becomes the seal itself.

83:14	their deeds were like rust on their hearts	رَأَى عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ مَا كَانُوا يَكْسِبُونَ
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Those wrong deeds which are done willingly, not under duress and coercion become like rust on their hearts and minds (16:106-108).

“الطَّبَقُ” (*at-tabaq*): the lid on anything which fits.
 “طَبَقَهُ طَبَقًا” (*tabbaqahu tatbiqah*): he covered it.
 “فَانْطَبَقَ” (*fantabaq*): thus he was covered.
 “الطَّبَقُ مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*at-tabaqu min kulli shaiyi*): anything which is equal to another thing or fits it.
 “طَبَقَهُ مُطَابَقَةً وَطَبَاقًا” (*tabaqahu mutabaqantan wa tibiaaqah*): he became equal and congruent.
 “الطَّبَقُ” (*at-tabaq*): earth, tray or big plate on which food is served, a century or an era, condition.
 “الْمُطَابَقَةُ” (*al-mutabaqah*): to be according to or in agreement with. For a horse to walk in such a way as the hind steps follow the front foot marks. A chained man’s walk, since his steps are very equal in size.
 “الْمُطَابَقَةُ بَيْنَ الشَّيْءَيْنِ” (*al-mutabaqah bainash shaiyeen*): to make two things according to one another or to place them on top of one another.

The Quran says:

67:3	in accordance with one another	الَّذِينَ خَلَقَ سَبْعَ سَمَاوَاتٍ طِبَاقًا
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Surah *Al-Inshiqaaq* says about the evolutionary stages of man:

84:19	You will continue to progress from one stage to another	لَتَرْكَبُنَّ طَبَقًا عَنْ طَبَقٍ
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In other words, humans will keep going up through different stages, or humanity itself will continue to rise step by step. History is the name of these stages. Also see heading (R-K-B).

“طَحَى” (*taha*), “يَطْحَى” (*yatha*), “طَحْيًا” (*tahya*): to spread something, to spread out or lay out. It means to be laid out.
 “الطَّاحِي” (*at-taahi*): a thing spread out on the ground or floor. It means a thing which permeates everything due to its abundance.
 “مَظْمَةٌ طَاحِيَّةٌ” (*mazannatun taahiya*): a big shed that is spread out.
 “الْقَمَرُ الطَّاحِي” (*al-qamarut taahi*): a high moon whose moonlight is spreading everywhere {T, *Kitab-ul-Ashfaq*}.

The Quran says:

91:6	the earth and the stages which have made it spread out	وَالْأَرْضِ وَمَا طَحَّيَهَا
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In other words, the different stages through which the earth’s fiery past condition passed and then became habitable for life.

“طَرَحَ” (*tarah*), “يَطْرَحُ” (*yatrah*), “طَرَحًا” (*tarhaa*): to throw away, to remove,
 “الطَّرْحُ” (*at-tirh*): a thing that has been discarded and which no one wants.
 “دِيَارُ طَوَارِحَ” (*dyarun tawarih*): a distant town or city.
 “الطَّرْحُ” (*at-tarah*): distance, a distant place.
 “قَوْسٌ طَرُوحٌ” (*qausun tarooh*): the bow which shoots an arrow afar.
 “طَرَفٌ مِطْرَحٌ” (*tarafun mitrah*): the eye that sees far ahead, or foresight {T, M, R}...

The Quran says that *Yusuf*’s brothers said (i.e. they discussed among themselves):

12:9	Kill <i>Yusuf</i> or send him to a distant land	أَوْاطِرْحُوهُ أَرْضًا
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“الطَّرْدُ” (*at-tard*): to distance (remove) someone thinking him to be lowly, outcaste.

“طَرَدْتُهُ” (*taradtuhu*): I ousted him.

“الطَّرِيدَةُ” (*at-tareedah*): the camels who are frightened away in an attack. It is also used for stolen camels.

It also means that prey which is hunted upon.

“أَطْرَدَهُ السُّلْطَانُ” (*atradahus sultaan*): the king exiled him.

“اسْتَطَرَدَ لَهُ” (*istatradalahu*): he feigned retreat but had actually fallen back so that he could regroup and attack again {*T, R*}.

Muheet writes that in the terminology of the Christians, to punish someone in religious matters is called “الطَّرْدُ” (*at-tard*).

The Quran says:

6:52	Those who call on their Sustainer, do not turn them away thinking them to be lowly	وَلَا تَطْرُدِ الَّذِينَ يَدْعُونَ رَبَّهُمْ
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The same people have been referred to by *Nooh* as:

26:114	I will not turn those <i>momineen</i> away from me, just because they are poor	وَمَا أَنَا بِطَارِدِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ
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In a non-Quranic System the criterion for status in a society is based on wealth and power while in a Quranic System the criterion is righteousness and ideological conformity. There is no discrimination on the basis of caste, creed, wealth, gender, power, status, colour, etc and righteousness is the only criterion which is used in carrying out the higher level tasks within the system. This is what could not be comprehended by those who were invited to this revolutionary program. They used to contend that “should we by accepting this program and become one of those who we think to be lowly in the society?” Therefore they demanded of the Messenger (*pbuh*) to distance him from them. Only then they would come and accept this program. They were referred to the criterion pronounced by the Quran which is based on righteousness.

“الطَّرْفُ” (*at-tarf*) means sight, or eye {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says that there are two basic meanings of this root. One is the edge of something, and second for any limb to move. It actually appears for an eye to bat a lid.

Raghib says that “الطَّرْفُ” (*at-tarf*) means to bat the eyelids. This has led to the word meaning “to see” {*T*}.

Surah *An-Namal* says:

27:40	before you can bat an eye lid (very soon)	قَبْلَ أَنْ يَرْتَدَّ إِلَيْكَ طَرْفُكَ
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Surah *Ash-Shoora* says:

42:45	to see from the corner of the eye	يَنْظُرُونَ مِنْ طَرْفٍ خَفِيٍّ
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“الطَّرْفُ” (*at-tarf*) also means the edge of anything where it ends, i.e. last frontier {*T*}.

The Quran says “طَرَفِي النَّهَارِ” (*tarafin nahaar*) in (11:114) and “أَطْرَافَ النَّهَارِ” (*atrafan nahaar*) in 20:130.

“أَطْرَافُ الْأَرْضِ” (*atraaful ard*) is the elite of the country {*T, Bustaan*}.

“الطَّرْفُ” (*at-tarf*): a gentleman, or horse of good breed, or man of high descent.

Surah *Ar-Raad* says:

13:41	Do they not see that We are (slowly and gradually) reducing economic resources and the fountainheads of Sustenance from these big people who are currently dominating them?	أَوَلَمْ يَرَوْا أَنَّا نَأْتِي الْأَرْضَ نَنْقُصُهَا مِنْ أَطْرَافِهَا
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The Quran had foretold about fifteen hundred years back that the resources of the world which have been seized by the powerful people will gradually go out of their hands and become the property of society and a Quranic society will use these resources for mankind. Verse (21:44) has pointed to this truth more explicitly.

“طَرْفٌ” (*tarfun*) also means a group or party, or the part of something {*Aqrabal Muuwaarid*}.
 “الطَّرْفُ” (*at-tarf*) also means selected thing {*T*}.

In surah *Aal-e-Imraan*, this word has appeared to mean this:

3:126	a part of them or one of their groups	طَرَفًا مِنَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا
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It may also mean powerful leaders of those who do not accept the permanent values as mentioned earlier.

T e - R - Q ط ر ق

“الطَّرْقُ” (*at-tarq*): to hit, or to hit repeatedly with a hammer, or to hit clearly.
 “الطَّرْقُ” (*at-tarq*), “الْمِطْرَقُ” (*al-mitraq*), “الْمِطْرَقَةُ” (*al-mitraqatah*): the stick with which the wool is hit to separate its fiber. It also means to hammer.
 “الطَّرْقُ” (*at-tarq*), “الطَّرُوقُ” (*at-turuq*): to come at night.
 “الطَّارِقُ” (*at-tariq*): someone who comes at night. It is called “طَارِقٌ” (*tariq*) because it has to knock (at night).

Raghib says “طَارِقٌ” (*tariq*) also means a passerby specially a traveler who arrives at night. Stars are also called “طَارِقٌ” (*at-tariq*) because they shine or come out at night {*T*}.

The Quran says:

86:1	By this <i>sama</i> and this <i>tariq</i>	وَالسَّمَاءِ وَالطَّارِقِ
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Ibn Faris says that this root has four meanings

- To come in the evening.
- To hit.
- For something to be loose.
- To sew something with another thing.

“الطَّرِيقَةُ” (*at-tuirqah*): the path leading to something.
 “طَرِيقَةٌ” (*tareeqah*): habit, behavior.
 “الطَّرِيقُ” (*at-tareeq*), “الطَّرِيقَةُ” (*at-tareeqah*): habit, a way. Plural is “الطَّرَائِقُ” (*at-tara'iq*) many ways.

Surah *Taha* says:

20:77	then take them by the dry path in the sea	فَاضْرِبْ لَهُمْ طَرِيقًا فِي الْبَحْرِ يَبَسًا
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Here “طَرِيقًا” (*tareeq*) means path. It also means the elite and influential people at the top who should set a good example for others.

“بُؤْلَاءُ طَرِيقَةً قَوْمِيهِمْ وَطَرَائِقُ قَوْمِيهِمْ” (*ha ulayi tareeqatu qoumihi wa tara-iq qoumihim*): these are the elite of the nation.
 “مِطْرَاقُ الشَّيْءِ” (*mitraaqush shaiyi*): a sample or specimen of something {*T*}.

Surah **Taha** says that the leaders of the nation said about **Moosa** and **Haroon**:

20:63	they wish to destroy your very good religion (or destroy the elite of your society)	يَذْهَبَا بِطَرِيقَتِكُمُ الْمُثَلَّى
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The same surah says later :

20:104	one who adopts the best way	أَمَّا لَهُمْ طَرِيقَةٌ
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Surah **Al-Jinn** say:

72:17	if they had stuck to the right path	لَوْ اسْتَقَامُوا عَلَى الطَّرِيقَةِ
72:11	we were on different paths (had different beliefs)	كُنَّا طَرَائِقَ قَدَدًا

“الطَّرِيقَةُ” (**at-tareeqah**): the things which are interlinked.

“الْمَطَارِيقُ” (**al-mataareeq**) are the camels which walk behind each other in a line.

“اِطْرَقَتِ الْاِبِلُ” (**at-taraqatal ibl**): the camels walked behind each other.

“اِطْرَقَتِ الْاَرْضُ” (**at-taraqatil ard**): the soil piled up over soil.

“اِطْرَقَتِ الْاَرْضُ” (**at-tiraaq**): the upper part of a shoe which is sewn by putting it over lower part {T}.

Quran says:

23:17	And certainly We created several paths above you	وَلَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا فَوْقَكُمْ سَبْعَ طَرَائِقَ
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Here “طَرَائِقُ” (**taraiq**) may also mean different sections of a society, or the heavenly bodies which are one above the other, orbiting after each other.

Te-R-W/Y

ط ر و ي

“اِطْرَيْ” (**at-tariyyu**): new, soft and fresh.

“طَرَى اللَّحْمُ وَطَرَاوَةٌ” (**tarrial lahum wutaru wa tarawah**): for the meat to be tender and fresh {T, R}.

The Quran says that the sea has “لَحْمَاطَرِيَّاءُ” (**lahman tariya**) which means fresh meat like fish etc. (16:14).

Te-Ain-M

ط ع م

“الطَّعَامُ” (**at-tuaam**): when it is said by itself then it means wheat or dates, otherwise it means everything that is eaten and which provide nourishment to human body.

“الطُّعْمَةُ” (**at-tu'amah**): a thing to eat, sustenance, earning a living.

“طَعْمُ الشَّيْءِ” (**ta'amnush shaiyi**): the taste of a thing.

“طَعِمَ” (**ta'ima**) and “تَطَعَّمَ” (**tuta-am**) means to taste {T}.

“طَعِمَ” (**ta'ima**) means he ate his fill.

“طَاعِمٌ” (**ta'imun**) means who has eaten or has a full stomach. It also means someone who does not need nor has no needs {T}.

Ibn Faris says this is its basic meaning i.e. who is self-sufficient.

“الطُّعْمُ” (**at-tu'am**): control and power.

“طَعِمَ عَلَيْهِ” (**ta'ima ilaih**): he had the power to {T}.

The Quran has used “طَعَامٌ” (**tu'aam**) to mean edible in (2:61), and to drink or taste in (2:249).

“اِطْعَمَ” (**at-taum**): he fed (106:4).

“اِسْتَطْعَمَ” (**istat'ama**): he asked for food (18:77).

Its general meaning is every kind of thing for sustenance:

107:3	And they do not feel the urge to feed the needy	وَلَا يَحُضُّ عَلَى طَعَامِ الْمِسْكِينِ
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Here it does not only mean to feed food, but also to provide the means of their living, or to make them free from need those who become incapacitated for some reason, or who cannot live a normal life due to some problems.

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:96	It is taken to mean the animals in the water that you hunt or those which the sea itself throws out are "halaal" {Ibn Jareer}	أَحِلَّ لَكُمْ صَيْدُ الْبَحْرِ وَ طَعَامُهُ
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Bustaan also says same about (5:96) as noted above.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that which is left behind by the receding sea is "طَعَامُ الْبَحْرِ" (*tu-aamul behr*).

Lissan-ul-Arab says "طَعَامُ الْبَحْرِ" (*tu-aamil behr*) means all those living things that are dependent for their life on the sea.

Te-Ain-N ط ع ن

"طَعَنَهُ بِالرُّمْحِ" (*ta'a-nahu bir rumhi yat'un*): means speared him, spiked him with a spear {T}.

"يَطْعُنُ" (*ta'ana feeh*): to find faults in somebody, to be satirical {T}.

"طَعَنَ فِيهِ" (*ta-anaa fid deen*): to find faults in Deen, criticize, and be satirical as quoted in (4:46).

Te-Gh-W/Y ط غ و/ي

"طَغَى" (*tagha*): to be out of limits, this is why flooding of a river water which comes out of its banks is called "طُغْيَانٌ" (*tughyaan*).

"أَطْعَى" (*atgha*): made him cross the limit, or limit breaker, instigated him to mutiny, made him rebellious.

"الطَّاغِي" (*at-taaghi*): one who goes out of limits and breaks the law. Plural is "الطَّاغُونَ" (*at-taaghoon*) and "الطَّاغِيْنَ" (*at- taagheen*).

"طَغْيَةٌ" (*taghya*) is a mountain difficult to climb.

"طَاغِيَّةٌ" (*taaghia*): oppressive and proud, foolish and harsh. It also means severe lightning and dangerous storm.

"طُغُوًى" (*taghwa*) means rebelliousness and breaking the limits {T, M, Lisan-ul-Arab}.

"طَاغُوتٌ" (*taaghoot*) has come from this, which is used for any limit breaker. It is also used for someone who detracts from the right path and puts on the wrong one {T, M, R}.

Johri says it means "leader of the rebels".

Zajaaj says that anything aside from Allah's system, if followed, is "طَاغُوتٌ" (*taghhoot*), i.e. every system or law not based on the permanent values of the Quran.

The Quran says about the *Firoun*:

20:43	he has become very rebellious	إِنَّهُ طَغَى
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In verse 2:15 "فِي طُغْيَانِهِمْ يَعْمَهُونَ" (*fi tughyaanihim yaamahoon*), the word "طُغْيَانٌ" (*tughyaan*) means rebellious, and in 78:22 "لِطَّاغِيْنَ" (*littaagheen*) has been used to mean rebellious as well.

The Quran has used the word "الطَّاغُوتُ" (*taaghoot*) against Allah at many places, which explains the meaning i.e. every system which is based on human exploitation .

Any force which rebels against Allah's law:

2:256	the one who believes in Allah and refuses to accept any other system not based on the permanent values	فَمَنْ يَكْفُرْ بِالطَّاغُوتِ وَيُؤْمِنْ بِاللَّهِ
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أَعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ “*la ilaha illal laah*” has this meaning as well. This has been explained as “سَبِيلُ اللَّهِ” (*sabilil laah*) and “سَبِيلُ الطَّاغُوتِ” (*sabilil taaghoot*) and has clarified that “طَّاغُوتٌ” (*taaghoot*) means every system against the permanent values. Those who fight for establishing a non-Godly or “طَّاغُوتٌ” (*taaghooti*) system, have been called “أَوْلِيَاءُ الشَّيْطَانِ” (*auliaish shaitaan*), which means “fellowship of rebellious” (4:76). This also shows that “طَّاغُوتٌ” (*taaghoot*) and “شَيْطَانٌ” (*shaitaan*) mean the same thing.

It has been further explained by saying:

4:60	These people want their decisions to be made by non-Godly forces	يُرِيدُونَ أَنْ يُتَحَاكَمُوا إِلَى الطَّاغُوتِ
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This shows that *shaitaan* and *taaghoot* are not merely mental concepts but *taaghoot* means all those rulers, the courts, those governments, those systems, which do not decide according to the Qurnic values but according to man-made laws. To refer to them is refusal of Allah and following of the non-Quranic values. Those who strengthen such systems are “أَوْلِيَاءُ الشَّيْطَانِ” (*auliyaush shaitaan*), i.e. working against the Quranic values.

The Quran says:

69:11	when the flood came	لَمَّا طَغَى الْمَاءُ
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“الطَّاغِيَةُ” (*at-taghiyah*) has appeared to mean severe thunder and lightning which had killed the nation of *Samood* (69:5). But this punishment was in response to their rebelliousness and establishing a system based on the human exploitation.

In surah *Ash-Shams* it is said:

91:11	<i>Samood</i> rejected the truth through their rebelliousness	كَذَّبَتْ ثَمُودُ بِطَغْوِيهَا
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Surah *An-Najam* says about the Messenger (*pbuh*):

53:17	his eye neither moved away from the right place, nor transgressed its limit	مَا زَاغَ الْبَصَرُ وَمَا طَغَى
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In other words, the Messenger rightly points to the guidance in the light of the revelation, but up to the point that Allah directed. He could not go beyond that point. As against other human beings, the Messenger’s knowledge due to the fact that he was aware of the source of the revelation, was very vast, but against the knowledge of Allah, it was confined within the defined limits. Allah gave the Messenger the amount of knowledge as He deemed necessary for the human guidance (The Quran). The messenger could not go beyond this defined limit.

ط ف أ T e - F - A

“طَفَّتِ النَّارُ” (*tafi-atin naar*), “أَنْطَفَأَتْ” (*antafaat*): the flame of the fire subsided and the fire cooled down.
 “أَطْفَأَ النَّارَ” (*atfa-annaar*): he doused the fire.
 “أَطْفَأَ نَارَ الْحَرْبِ” (*atfa naaral herb*): he doused the fire of war {T}.

The Quran says:

5:64	whenever they fan the flames of war, God douses them (metaphorically)	كُلَّمَا أَوْقَدُوا نَارًا لِلْحَرْبِ أَطْفَأَهَا اللَّهُ
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“أَطْفَأَ الْفِتْنَةَ” (*atfas'al fitnah*): calming down passions or flames {M}.

Linguist scholars say that a fire which does not have any more flames left, but its ambers are still hot and glowing, is called “خَامِدَةٌ” (*khamidah*), but when the flames cool down and the ambers are cooled too, it is called “هَامِدَةٌ” (*haamidah*) and “طَافَةٌ” (*ta'efah*) {*T*}.

Raghib says that (9:32) means that “they want to put out the Light of Allah”, and (61:11) means that “they want to adopt a strategy whereby they can put out Allah’s Light, but Allah will certainly complete his Light and this will be done through His system overwhelming all other systems”. Also see (61:9), (9:33).

Te-F-F ط ف ف

“الطَّافِيفُ” (*at-tafeef*): a small amount, incomplete thing, useless or insignificant thing.
 “الطَّفَافَةُ” (*at-tufaafah*): that much space as is left in filling a vessel.
 “طَفَّ النَّاقَةَ يَطْفُفُهَا” (*taifun naaqatah yatuffuha*): he tied a camel’s legs (so it couldn’t walk).
 “طَفَّتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*ataffatin naaqah*): a camel gave birth to an incomplete progeny.
 “طَفَّفَ الْمِكْيَالَ” (*taffafal mikyaal*): he did not fill the cup completely, and left it partially filled {*R*}.

The Quran says:

83:1	And there is destruction for <i>mutaffafeen</i>	وَيْلٌ لِّلْمُطَفِّفِينَ
83:2	who are those, who take full measure while taking,	الَّذِينَ إِذَا أَكْتَالُوا عَلَى النَّاسِ يَسْتَوْفُونَ
83:3	but while giving, shorten the measure	وَإِذَا كَالُوهُمْ أَوْ وَزَنُوهُمْ يُخْسِرُونَ

The Quran has said that this action results in destruction and annihilation. This is the description of a society in which the capitalists and the ruling class do not give full returns for the labor of others, but instead they live better at the expense of others. In a capitalist system no one is given the full return for his work. If full compensation is paid, then what will the capitalist get? The capitalist tries to give laborers the lowest possible and keeps the maximum possible for himself. This is what maintains capitalism. The Quran calls this as “تَطْفِيفٌ” (*tatfeef*) and says this system will result in destruction. This word also hints at (like tying the legs of a camel) that the capabilities of the workers are never realized and they remain stilted, incomplete, and shackled. As such, “تَطْفِيفٌ” (*tatfeef*) would mean not only inequity but it would also include lack of respect for humanity.

In whatever way respect for humanity is lowered, is “تَطْفِيفٌ” (*tatfeef*). A society in which human respect is lessened or he is not respected as a human being is a society of “مُطَفِّفِينَ” (*mutfafeen*) and its ultimate result is destruction.

Te-F-Q ط ف ق

“طَفِقَ يَفْعَلُ كَذَا” (*tafiqa yaf-alu kaza*): he started doing it. This is said when a man starts doing something and remains engaged in it.
 “طَفِقَ الْمَوْضِعَ” (*tafiqal mauzih*): he remained stolid at that place and did not move from there {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

7:22	they started to do so	وَطَفِقُوا يَحْكُمِينَ
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“الطَّفْلُ” (*at-tafl*): any soft and delicate thing.
 “طُفْلٌ” (*taful*), “طَفَالَةٌ” (*tafalah*), “طُفُولَةٌ” (*tafulah*): to be soft and delicate.
 “الطِّفْلِ” (*at-tifl*): any small thing. It is also used for a child. Plural is “أَطْفَالٌ” (*itffaal*) as in (44:59).
 “طِفْلٌ” (*tifl*) is also used as a plural.

Raghib says a child is called “طِفْلٌ” (*tifl*) till he remains soft and delicate {*R*}.

The Quran says:

22:5	then create you (give birth to you) as a child	ثُمَّ نَخْرِجُكُمْ طِفْلًا
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“الطَّلَبُ” (*at-talab*): the wish to have something in such a way that one has to strive to get it {*M*} or the search or struggle to find something {*R*}. It means to be in search of something and to get it.
 “طَلَبَ إِلَيْهِ” (*talabna ilaih*): he asked him for it.
 “كَلَامُطَلَبٌ” (*kal-un mutlib*): grass that is far from the water and one has to strive to get to it.
 “أُمُّ طَلَبَةٍ” (*ummu tilbah*): eagle. This incorporates both, the sense of distance and search {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

18:41	Then get it after searching	فَلَنْ تَسْتَطِيعَ لَهُ طَلَبًا
22:73	the one who demands and who is demanded	الطَّالِبُ وَ الْمَطْلُوبُ

“الطَّلْحُ” (*at-talh*): a tall tree under whose shade people rest. It has few leaves and thorns aplenty. It is also used for a tree which is used to feed camels.

Abu Ishaq says that it means banana tree.

“طَلْحٌ” (*talhun*) also appears to mean the same as “طَلْعٌ” (*tal'a*). See heading (Te-L-Ain)
 “رَجُلٌ طَالِحٌ” (*rajulun taalih*): means a bad man who has no goodness. It is opposite of “صَالِحٌ” (*saleh*).
 “بَعِيرٌ طَالِحٌ” (*baeerun tilh*): tired and weak camel.
 “الطَّلْحُ” (*at-talah*): by another meaning it also means benevolence {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means a kind of tree and weakness or feebleness.

The Quran says while describing *jannat* or heavenly society:

56:29	row upon row of banana trees	طَالِحٌ مُنْضُودٌ
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“طَلَعَ” (*tala'a*), “طَلُوْا” (*tulu'a*): to appear, become evident (rising of the sun etc.) {*T, M*} (20:130).
 “مَطْلَعٌ” (*matla'a*) and “مَطْلَعٌ” (*matl'e*): the place to appear or rise (18:90), or the time to arise. It is also a noun i.e. it also means to appear and be evident.

Surah *Al-Qadar* uses it to mean the time of sunrise (97:5).

“طَلَعَ الْجَبَلُ” (*tala'al jabal*): he climbed the mountain.
 “إِطَّلَعَ عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*ittala aslal amr*): he came to know something or became aware of it.
Isma-ee says that “مُطْلَعٌ” (*muttala*) means a ladder which is used for climbing {*T*}.
 “إِطَّلَعَ عَلَيْهِ” (*ittala ilaih*): he climbed up and looked below.
 “مُطْلَعٌ” (*muttali*) means one who so looks down (37:54-55).

Fara says “إِطْلَاعٌ” (*ittil'a*) and “بُلُوْغٌ” (*bulugun*) mean the same, i.e. to reach someone (28:38).

“تَطَّلَعَ عَلَى الْأَفْئِدَةِ” (*tattali-u alal af'eda*): which reaches or touches the heart (104:7).
 “إِطَّلَعَ عَلَى بَاطِنِهِ” (*ittala'a ala baatibihi*): came to know his internal condition {*T, M*}.
 “الطَّلُوعُ” (*attulu*): to rise and appear with success and respect {*T, M*}.
 “نَخْلَةٌ مُطْلَعَةٌ” (*nakhlatur muilti'ah*): the date palm which is taller than the date palms around it {*M*}.
 “الطَّلْعُ” (*attaali'u*): the arrow which misses the target and hits above it {*T, M*}.
 “أُطْلِعَ عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*atla'ahu alal amr*): informed him of the matter (3:178)
 “الطَّلْعُ” (*at-tal'u*): The outer layer of a date-palm which has several pointy segments. See (50:10), (37:65), and (26:148).

“طَلَّقَ” (*talaq*): became free, got liberated.
 “طَلَّقَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ مِنْ زَوْجِهَا” (*talaq til mar'atu min zaujeha*): the woman got separated from her husband.
 “أَطْلَقَ الْأَسِيرَ” (*atlaqal aseer*): freed the prisoner.
 “نَاقَةٌ طَالِقٌ” (*naaqatun taaliq*): a camel without a lead, liberated.
 “الطَّلَاقَةُ” (*at-taliqah*): the camel which is let free to roam and eat and drink from anywhere.
 “الطَّلْقُ” (*at-talqu*): a deer which is free, or a camel which is not imprisoned i.e. owned by someone.
 “لِسانٌ طَلْقٌ” (*lisaanun tuluq*), “وَطْلُقٌ” (*watulaq*): sharp tongue with no control.
 “مُطْلَقٌ” (*mutlaq*) is the opposite of “مُقَيَّدٌ” (*muqayyad*) which means “imprisoned” {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says “فَانْطَلَقَا” (*fantalaaqaha*) in (18:71) which means “both of them left”.
 “وَانْطَلَقَ الْمَلَأُ” (*wantalaqal mala'u*): the big leaders (with alacrity) began to say (38:6).

Moosa said to God:

26:13	My tongue will not move freely or easily (e.g. lack of fluency)	لَا يَنْطَلِقُ لِسَانِي
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Perhaps *Moosa* thought this because of staying so long in desert and rural set up and was away from urban areas. Perhaps he thought he would not be able to speak so freely in the Pharaoh's court.

Raghib says “طَلَّاقٌ” (*talaq*) means to free someone from some bondage or to deliver. Later it came to be used for a husband to let a wife go free of wedlock (2:227).

“طَلَّاقٌ” (*talaq*) means to give divorce in (2:236).
 “مُطَلَّاقَةٌ” (*mutallaqah*): a divorced woman. The plural is “مُطَلَّقاتٌ” (*mutallaqaat*) as used in (2:241).

According to the Quran, a nuptial contract is a willing pact between an two adults i.e. a man and a woman. See heading (N-K-H). Therefore if a situation arises in which they cannot live peacefully

together then this pact can be dissolved and both can be free from this pact. The Quran has given explicit instructions as to how this pact can be dissolved.

In some parts of the Muslim world there is an un-Quranic custom where the husband has the right to break the nuptial contract at any time by saying thrice the word **talaaq**. Thereafter this pair cannot live together until the woman marries another man and commits **halalah** by sleeping with him one night, then divorce him as well and then get remarried to her first husband, that is, if she desires to live with him again. Otherwise it is thought to be against Islam. This practice is totally non-Quranic (& uncivilized as well).

For the Quranic meaning of “الطَّلَاقُ مَرَّتَيْنِ” (**at-talaqun martaan**), see heading (M-R-R). Here it will suffice to say that a man will say the word **talaaq** when a man and wife will be actually free from the bondage of wedlock i.e. once the decision to implement divorce has been agreed by both parties. The intention to divorce or its initial stages will not be called **talaaq** or divorce – the Quran has outlined the process.

Here one must note that for one the word **talaaq** has come from the word “طَلَّقَ” (**talaga**) which means to become free. Secondly this word has “طَلَقَ” (**talag**) as noun which means to set free. From understanding the Quran it appears that to dissolve a marriage is not just a matter between a husband and wife, but one has to refer it to the court in this matter. The decision for divorce must be given by a court. This way “طَلَّاقٌ” (**talaaq**) meaning will be to set free or liberate and this seems most appropriate.

T e-L-L ط ل ل

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is freshness, softness, and delicacy, as well as to peep, and also to declare something false.

“الطَّلُ” (**at-tal**): light rain, a shower, rather the dew which is witnessed in open air {T} (2:265).
 “الطَّلَالَةُ” (**at-talah**): happiness, pleasure, beauty, freshness, life’s pleasantness {T}.
 “الطَّلُّ” (**at-tul**) means light rain because it lends freshness to land.

T e-M-Th ط م ث

“الطَّمْتُ” (**at-tams**) means “to touch”.
 “بَدَأَ جَمَلٌ مَّا طَمَّتْهُ حَبْلٌ قَطُّ” (**haaza jamalun ma tamasahu hablun qat**): this is a camel that no rope has touched (that is, it has always been free of ropes).
 “طَمَّتِ الْمَرْأَةُ” (**tamasal mar’ah**): he touched the woman. Some have said it means having sex.
 “الطَّمْتُ” (**at-tamsu**) also means accusation, dirt, and chaos {T}.

About the women’s honor (purity) in a heavenly society, it is said:

55:56	they have never been touched by anyone whether a stranger or a known man	لَمْ يَطْمِثْهُنَّ إِنْسٌ قَبْلَهُمْ وَلَا جَانٌّ
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This provides a great satisfaction to know about the modesty of the marrying partner that she is pure and untouched. (This is equally applicable to man as well (24:30-31)).

“طَمَسَ” (*tamas*): was obliterated. Its traces were also removed.

“طَمَسْتُهُ طَمْسًا” (*tamastuhu tamsa*): I obliterated him, removed even his traces.

The Quran says:

4:47	before we destroy them	قَبْلَ أَنْ نَطْمِسَ وَجُوهًا
10:88	destroys their wealth	رَبَّنَا اطْمِسْ عَلَى أَمْوَالِهِمْ

“طَمِيسٌ” (*tamees*), “مَطْمُوسٌ” (*mutmoos*): blind, one who sees nothing {T}.

In surah *Al-Qamar* it is been said about the nation of *Loot* that:

54:27	from the volcanoes of Sodom such sulfuric fire and ash was emitted that they went blind	فَطَمَسْنَا أَعْيُنَهُمْ
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It could also means going blind due to being overwhelmed by their desires . See (36:66).

Surah *Al-Murselaat* says:

77:8	when the stars lose their light	فَإِذَا النُّجُومُ طُمِسَتْ
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Raghib says “طَمَعَ” (*tama*) means for human desire to lean towards something. It has both elements of greed and hope.

Ibn Faris says it means to have an intense desire and hope for something.

“الْمَطْمَعُ” (*al-matmah*): the thing which is hoped for or desired, or something that catches the eye {T}. It also means the bird which is used in a net to attract other birds with a view to trap them in the net {L}.

In the Quran, this word has appeared against “خَوْفٌ” (*khaufun*) in (13:12). “خَوْفٌ” (*khaufun*) means the feeling of loss, therefore “الْمَطْمَعُ” (*tama-un*) is the hope of profit or gain.

The Quran says:

70:38	Does every man in them have this desire?	أَيُّطْمَعُ كُلُّ امْرِئٍ مِنْهُمْ
74:15	then he also expects Me to keep increasing it	ثُمَّ يَطْمَعُ أَنْ أَزِيدَ

“طَمَّ الْمَاءُ يَطْمُ” (*tammal ma-u yatumm*): the water covered something and engulfed it.

“طَمَّ السَّيْلُ الرَّكِيَّةَ” (*tammal sailur rakiyyah*): the flood filled the well and made it level {T}.

“طَمَّ الْبَاءَرُ” (*tammal bi'r*): filled a well with soil and leveled it {F}.

“طَمَّ الطَّاءِرُ الشَّجَرَ” (*tammal tairush shajar*): bird sat on high part of a tree.

“الطُّمُّ” (*al-timmu*): Sea, water galore.

“الطَّامَّةُ” (*at-tamma*): the sound of a shriek which engulfs everything {T}.

“الطَّامَّةُ الْكُبْرَى” (*at-tammatal kubra*): Great revolution (79:43). That is, the moment of judgment that engulfs everything like a flood.

“طَامَّةٌ” (*tammah*): an event which levels any highs and lows

“الطَّمَنُ” (*at-tamm*): immobile, unmoving.

“فِيهِ تَطَامُنٌ” (*fihi tatamun*): it has peace and grandeur {R, M}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says *Ibrahim* asked Allah how He raises the dead. Allah asked him whether he did not believe this or doubted this. He replied “بَلَىٰ” (*bala*), “on the contrary, the conviction is there but”:

2:260	I want to know for certain	وَلَكِنْ لِّيَطْمَئِنَّ قُلُوبِي
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This shows the real meaning of “إِطْمِئْنَانٌ” (*itminaana*), that is, the belief which turns into conviction requires evidence which is due to seeing with own eyes, which is the result not merely of reasoning alone but based on observation, knowledge, and experience. This is why the Quran has declared “اطمئنان قلب” (*itminaani qalb*), that is, the satisfaction of the mind, to be the opposite of “إِكْرَاهٌ” (*ikraah*) in (16:106). “اطمئنان قلب” (*ikraah*) means to get something accepted by force. See heading (K-R-H). Thus “اطمئنان قلب” (*itminaani qalb*) would mean to accept something from the bottom of the heart and mind, that is, with full willingness based on evidence.

Surah *An-Nahal* describes “أَمْنٌ” (*amn*) and “إِطْمِئْنَانٌ” (*itminaana*) separately (6:112). Although for “إِطْمِئْنَانٌ” (*itminaana*) the presence of “أَمْنٌ” (*amn*) has been described as necessary (2:103). This shows that if there is “أَمْنٌ” (*amn*) or peace in the country, then hearts also have “إِطْمِئْنَانٌ” (*itminaana*). “أَمْنٌ” (*amn*) is the name of being safe from external dangers, but “إِطْمِئْنَانٌ” (*itminaana*) is that condition in which a man is safe from internal struggle or confusion and this is obtained not by escaping the truth but by gaining knowledge and facing reality. This is the condition of a human personality which has been called “*jannah*” (89:27). But this has been made absolutely clear that this cannot be possible through isolation or monasticism. This can only be obtained by living within a society based on the permanent values.

That is why it is said:

89:29	the first condition for entering “ <i>jannah</i> ” is that man lives along with other humans	فَادْخُلِي فِي عِبَادِي
89:30	and there they all live according to Allah’s laws	وَادْخُلِي جَنَّتِي
13:28	real peace of mind can only be gained through living according to Allah’s laws	الَّذِينَ يَذْكُرُونَ اللَّهَ تَطْمَئِنُّ الْقُلُوبُ

See heading (Dh-K-R) which will explain clearly that mention of Allah is not to repeat Allah’s name over and over again on a thread of pearls, but it means to keep Allah’s laws in mind all the time i.e. to have knowledge of these values and a desire to refer to them in all matters of life. The first result of this is the abundance of sustenance (16:112). If peace of mind is the ultimate aim of life, (according to every individual), then there will be no distinction between good and evil. When a robber or con man kills someone and then atones at the altar of the *Kali* goddess or some other god, then he gets solace which is no less than one who believes in God. Therefore life’s destiny is not only peace of mind, which is usually close to one’s wishes. The ultimate aim in life is to create a society in which every decision is made according to justice and fair play, so every individual gets peace of mind along with peace of society. “مُتَمَتِّعِينَ” (*mutmayineen*): those who live satisfied (17:95).

“الطَّهَارَةُ” (*at-tarah*) basically means for something to be free of dirtiness {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means cleanliness and removal of dirt from something.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “طَهَّرَهُ” (*taharahu*) means to “remove him”, or “distance him”.

The Quran says about *Isa*:

3:54	Allah will distance you from these people (who deny the truth you present) and take you away	وَمُطَهِّرُكَ مِنَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا
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“تَطَهَّرَ” (*tatheer*) means to cleanse something of impurities and make it pure.

“طَاهِرٌ” (*taahir*) means pure and clean.

“مُطَهَّرَةٌ” (*mutah-hirah*) is more intense than “طَاهِرَةٌ” (*taahirah*), that is, very pure.

“طُهورٌ” (*tahoor*) means a thing from which purity is obtained, or it means a pure thing which makes other things pure as well.

The Quran describes rainwater as “مَاءٌ طَهُورٌ” (*ma-un tahoora*) in (25:28) because it is from distillation process, and also cleans other things.

“طَهْرٌ” (*tuhrun*): period or time when a woman is free of menstruation, that is, when a woman is free of menstruation. According to *Ibnul Airaabi*, it is called “طَهْرَتٌ” (*taharat*). When a woman has bathed (after her period has stopped) it is called “تَطَهَّرَتْ” (*tatah harat*) {T}.

The Quran says:

2:222	And do not approach them until they are cleansed, then approach them once they have been purified	وَلَا تَقْرُبُوهُمْ حَتَّىٰ يَطْهَرُوا فَإِذَا تَطَهَّرُوا فَأْتُوهُمْ
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The fine difference is explained here i.e. between stopping of period and subsequent cleanliness through washing.

The Quran has used the word “طَهَارَتٌ” (*taharat*) to mean not only cleanliness related to our body, but also cleanliness and purity related to our inner thought process.

The Quran says:

5:41	it is not Allah's Will to purify their hearts	لَمْ يُرِدِ اللَّهُ أَنْ يَطْهَرَ قُلُوبَهُمْ
56:79	only those will comprehend the Quranic Values who have purified hearts	لَا يَحْشُرُهُ إِلَّا الْمُطَهَّرُونَ

The Quran as a complete book makes it clear that only those can benefit from its values who approach it with unprejudiced mind with no preconceived ideas and beliefs (28:50). They must not be looking support for their own views or the prevalent beliefs of a society. The desire must be to find a higher meaning of life with a view to find solution to the human problems on a universal basis (13:17). This is why the Quran invites us to use our intellect and reasoning to understand every verse and its contents (25:73). The Quran deals with the human self and its thinking process and since it is not a product of the human intellect, therefore it cannot be produced by any human being. It states that no human being can produce any part of the book, because human beings do not think like this. The whole purpose of the Quran is to provide an option to those who look for a higher purpose of life and wish to establish a system based on the permanent values with a view to resolve those issues which human intellect can never solve without the light of the Quran. The important point to note in this term is that it also means remaining distant from the message of the Quran despite reading it or being closer to it or thinking to be close to it. The Quran explains the human thinking process including emotions, desires, free will, memory, death, differences, etc and then provides explanations of the alternative in the light of the permanent values with models. Also see heading (M-S-S). Those who are aware of the importance of this life and wish to safeguard against the vulnerabilities of this life and wish to pursue a defined path of righteousness, are called *muttaqeen*, and it is the *muttaqeen* whom the Quran guides (2:2).

“رَجُلٌ طَابِرُ النَّيَابِ” (*rajulun taahirus siyaab*) means a man who is very pure {M}. The Arabs usually use the word “نَيَابٌ” (*siyaab*) to mean personality or character {M}.
 “وَنِيَابِكَ فَطَهِّرْ” (*wa siyabaka fatah hir*) in (74:4) would mean to remove and eliminate all base thoughts from one’s mind and make himself the embodiment of purity i.e. replacing these thoughts with righteous thinking. If “نَيَابٌ” (*siyaab*) is taken to mean invitation to others then the phrase would mean that you must keep your revolutionary invitation free from all those whose thoughts are not pure and thus will be hindrance in this task of yours. Only those who can purify their thoughts from all not Quranic thinking and concepts, can be included in this team. This will also mean to only include the Quranic concepts in extending this invitation. For the meaning of “نَيَابٌ” (*siyaab*), see heading (Th-W-H).

In surah *Al-Ahzaab* the family of the Messenger (*pbuh*) has been told:

33:33	We will keep you away from all accusations and grant you purity of thoughts.	وَيُطَهِّرُكُمْ تَطْهِيراً
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The trained and puritan companions of a heavenly society are called “أَزْوَاجٌ مُطَهَّرَةٌ” (*azwaajun mutah hira*) in (2:25). This includes wives as well as husbands, as well as other companions. See heading (Z-W-J).

T e - W - D ط و د

“الطُّودُ” (*at-taud*): High Mountain, or high sand dune.
 “الطَّادُ” (*at-taad*): heavy and stable thing which is stable in its place.
 “طَادَ الشَّيْءُ” (*taadash shaiy’u*): the thing became static at one place.
 “بِنَاءٌ مُنْتَادٌ” (*bina-un muntaad*): high building {T, R}.

The Quran says:

29:63	Like a big rock or dune.	كَالطُّودِ الْعَظِيمِ
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T e - W - R ط و ر

“الطُّورُ” (*at-tuur*): Green Mountain (with vegetation). If the mountain is not green it is not called “طُورٌ” (*tuur*) {T}.

Ibn Faris says that it means for a thing to be long and growing, whether it is concerned with place or time, and a mountain is called “طُورٌ” (*tuur*) because of its length, breadth, and increased height.

“الطُّورُ” (*at-tuur*) is the name of a mount near *Ailah*, which is also called *Saina*, *Sineen* or *Sinai* {T} (95:2, 23:20). The invitation of *Moosa* began from that mount. At the foot of this very mount *Bani Israeel* made a pact with *Moosa* regarding his invitation (2:63).

“الطُّورُ” (*at-tuur*): times.
 “طُورَابَعْدَ طُورٍ” (*tauran baa’datur*): the second time after one time. It also means that which is equivalent to something. “طُورٌ” (*tuur*) also means this.
 “الطُّوَارُ” (*atwaar*): different limits or kinds, different stages or conditions or estimates {T}.

The Quran says:

71:14	Allah has passed you through different stages before taking you to the human stage	قَدْ خَلَقْنَاكُمْ أَطْوَارًا
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In other words human creation has been made possible by passing through different stages, or humans have been created through different conditions before reaching the existing condition.

“يَطُورُ” (*yatoor*) means to be close {M}.

“طَاعَ” (*ta’a*) means for something to become wider or vast.

“طَاعَ لَهُ الْمَرْتَعُ” (*ta’a lahul marta’au*): the grazing field became wider for it and he grazed wherever he wanted {T}. This brings the basic meaning of “اطاعت” (*ata’at*) before us. That is to accept a thing with a willingness of the heart (with no reservation).

The Quran has used “طَوَّعًا” (*tu-an*) against “كَرْهًا” (*karha*) in (41:11). “كَرْهًا” (*karha*) means to do something under coercion or unwillingly. As such, “طَوَّعًا” (*tu-an*) would mean to do something willingly and with pleasure.

“اطَاعَ النَّخْلُ” (*atan nakhl*) means when dates are ripened {T}. There is no need to use force to pluck them because they are themselves ready to be plucked.

“اطَاعَ” (*ata’a*) means to follow an order willingly.

“طَاوَعَهُ” (*ta’awa’ahu*) means to be in agreement with him {T}

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be attached to someone and become willingly obedient.

Raghib says “اِسْتَطَاعَ” (*istatah*) means that for the accomplishment of some task, all the necessary abilities, means and resources are available. If some of these means are available and while some are not present then it will be called “مُسْتَطَاعٌ” (*mustateeh*).

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says:

2:158	undergo a little trouble to do some righteous deed	وَمَنْ تَطَوَّعَ خَيْرًا
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It certainly involves willingness, but if one has to bear some hardship to carry out a righteous task then one must accept this hardship and carry out the task (2:184).

Surah **An-Nahal** says about non Godly powers:

16:73	people with no authority	لَا يَسْطِيعُونَ
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In other words, the power and abilities needed for doing and completing some tasks are missing from them.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says:

2:217	If they come across power to do so, then they will try to turn you away from your Deen	يُرْذَوْنَ عَنْ دِينِكُمْ إِنْ اِسْتَطَاعُوا
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Surah **Al-Ma'idah** says:

5:30	His desires made him agree to this work	فَطَوَّعَتْ لَهُ نَفْسُهُ
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The Quran has stressed the need to willingly obey the laws of Allah by using one's freedom to choose. In fact, the teachings of the entire Quran are focused on this single aspect to invite us to use this option to develop our self and then to team together to establish a system based on the permanent values. This is the system which those of us who will be righteous, will find in the hereafter (82:17-19). The obedience here means to do something with full willingness of the heart and mind - this is only possible when one accepts an ideology through the willing use of all the intellect and reasoning supported by the facts. This obedience cannot be equated with the forced obedience of a man directed system where development of the human self is never accepted as an issue. The whole man driven system is narrowly focused on the economic aspects of the human living and is based on meeting the physical needs. This is what Islam means i.e. to accept the Quran as a complete book which provides guidance for the development of the self within the domain of the permanent values. It is obvious that this sort of obedience can be made possible neither with coercion nor can the obedience be done blindly.

This is why the Quran has explained the effects of following the injunctions and the values and then given historical examples using the messengers as human models. This is not other worldly message and is very much about establishing a system based on the permanent values in this life. This is done through human hands; humans, who willingly accept these values and then come together to establish a system for the good mankind.

The word “تَوَلَّى” (*tawalla*) has come opposite this term e.g. in (3:31). That is, to turn away or find ways of avoiding some values and guidance. One needs to understand there that if there is a slight hesitation in doing something, then it will not be obedience, because obedience embodies the element of willingness. Obedience is done willingly and not made to be done forcibly for it to be effective. Unwitting error is something else (and condonable), but if someone does not want to stay within Allah’s system, then he cannot be made to do so forcibly, nor can anybody be made to come within the system by force.

Therefore, the Quran has declared unambiguously that there is no coercion in **Deen** (2:256). Those who do not accept this system willingly will live in the Islamic state like non-Muslims. They will enjoy all human rights but they will have no say in the running of the affairs of the state. It should be made clear here that in such a system everyone is equal as a human being as far as the basic needs are concerned and since the system has to be managed within the permanent values of the Quran, therefore this cannot be implemented by those who do not accept the Quran willingly as a book of guidance. This is indeed, managing the system on behalf of Allah as explained in the Quran and none can do so, unless the team understands the Quran using full metacognition knowledge, skills and experience – this will need education, training and understanding before taking this massive responsibility whose rewards are infinite (3:133).

“مُطَاعٌ” (*muta’in*): he who is obeyed (81:21).

“مُتَوَّعٌ” (*muttawih*): he who engages in some work with full heart (9:79).

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says that *Isa's* companions said:

5:112	Will Allah accept this prayer of ours?" {R}	هَلْ يَسْتَسْطِيعُ رَبُّكَ أَنْ يُنَزِّلَ عَلَيْنَا مَائِدَةً
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Surah *Al-Momin* says:

40:18	such whose request can be granted	مَا لِلظَّالِمِينَ مِنْ حِمِيمٍ وَلَا شَفِيعٍ يُطَاعُ
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Surah *Al-Kahaf* uses “إِسْطَاعٌ” (*istah*) instead of “إِسْطَايَ” (*istatyah*) in (18:97).

T e - W - F ط و ف

“طَوَّفَ” (*tauf*) means to go round and encircle.

“طَافَ” (*taaf*), “إِسْطَافَ” (*istaaf*), “تَطَوَّفَ” (*tatawwaf*), “طَوَّفَ” (*tawwaf*): to go around, encircle, to walk a lot around a thing or object {T}{M}.

“الْمَطَافُ” (*al-mataaf*): the place to go around.

“الطَّائِفُ” (*attaa-if*): guard which guards at night. This word is also used as a plural {T}. *Ibn Faris* too says that this is the meaning.

“الطَّائِفَةُ” (*at-taafah*): the piece of something, a group of people which is united because of the same Deen or school of thought and is prominent due to this {M}.

Ibn Faris says that the Arabs did not limit “طائفه” (*taifah*) to any quantity, but he also says it is generally used for a little quantity.

“الطَّوَّافُ” (*at-tawwaf*): a servant who is very soft and courteous in serving {M}.

“الطَّوْفَانُ” (*at-toofaan*): all-encompassing death. It means that event or incident which encircles a community, nation, etc from all sides and overwhelms everything, such as flooding, civil war, mayhem, heavy rains, etc. It also means intense darkness of the night {T}.

The Quran says about the nation of *Nooh*:

29:14	they were engulfed by a storm	فَأَخَذَهُمُ الطُّوفَانُ
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“طَافَ” (*taafa*), “يَطُوفُ” (*rajuuf*): also means to go for defecation {*T*}.

The Quran says:

37:45	a drink will do the rounds on them	يُطَافُ عَلَيْهِمْ بِكَأْسٍ
24:58	they keep moving ground on you	طَوَّافُونَ عَلَيْكُمْ بَعْضُكُمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ
68:19	a destruction visited them from your Sustainer	فَطَافَ عَلَيْهَا طَائِفٌ مِنْ رَبِّكَ
7:201	a rebellious thought which comes wandering into the mind	طَلْفٌ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ
3:121	group or party	طَائِفَةٌ
2:125	<i>Kaaba</i> is a central place for those who protect the rights of people (guards of humanity)	أَنْ طَهَّرَابَتِي لِلطَّائِفِينَ وَالْعَاكِفِينَ

“عَاكِفِينَ” (*aakifeen*) means people, who do not let humanity disintegrate, rather keep them together or united, keep their affairs all right, and maintain a balance in the world affairs. See heading (Ain-K-F).

The Quran has declared that the *momins* as an international community are those whose duty it is to look after the affairs of the whole world. For this purpose the center they will establish is *Kaaba* (2:143). Thus the group which establishes this system which guards humanity is called “طَائِفِينَ” (*tu-ifeen*), or the protector of human rights as enshrined in the Quran. This is why when *Ibrahim* asked Allah whether the system of up keeping the *Kaaba* will continue in his descendants, he was told:

2:124	those who do wrong will not be fit for this responsibility	لَا يَنْتَهِ عَهْدِي الظَّالِمِينَ
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This is what the encircling of the *Kaaba* really means, which is symbolically performed by going round and round the Kaaba. Just like the bowing, genuflecting etc. in prayers are symbolic of obedience to Allah and Allah alone, so is this congregation of *Hajj* the displayable shape of the Islamic nation banding together for the good of mankind.

ط و ق T e - W - Q

“الطَّوْقُ” (*at-tauq*): collar, or anything which encircles.

Raghib says “طَوَّقَ” (*tauq*) is the collar one is born with, like the collar of a bird, or artificial collar like golden or silver necklace.

“تَطَوَّقَ” (*tatawwaq*): to wear a collar {*T*}, to make one wear a collar (3:180).

Taj-ul-Uroos, *Raghib*, *Ibn Faris* and *Aqrabil Muwarid* all agree that “الطَّاقَةُ” (*at-taaqah*) means a force which can be employed to do something although unwillingly. That is, the work seems so difficult or disliked as if someone has put a collar around the neck.

They quote the Quran where it says:

2:286	do not burden us with tasks which are difficult for us	لَا تُحْمَلُنَا مَا لَا طَاقَةَ لَنَا بِهِ
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It does not mean that do not burden us with something which we cannot perform, but tasks which are difficult for us {*T*, *M*, *R*}.

About the orders of fasting, the Quran says:

2:184	those who can fast but with difficulty must offer compensation instead of fasting i.e. can give up fasting by giving compensation	وَعَلَى الَّذِينَ يُطِيقُونَهُ فِدْيَةٌ طَعَامُ مِسْكِينٍ
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Ordinarily it is taken to mean that those who have the strength or ability to fast (or to give donation or compensation) can give up fasting by giving donation. These meanings are wrong. If those who can give compensation are exempt from fasting then who is going to fast as a duty?

It means that those who can fast but with difficulty must give compensation instead of fasting, because:

2:185	God does not want to create difficulties for you but to ease it up.	يُرِيدُ اللَّهُ بِكُمْ الْيُسْرَ لَا يُرِيدُ بِكُمْ الْعُسْرَ
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Al Munaar says that the Arabs say “أَطَاقَ الشَّيْءَ” (*ayaqash shaiyi*) when the power is insufficient to do a certain thing or one has to face great difficulty in doing something.

“الَّذِينَ يُطِيقُونَهُ” (*al-lazeena yuqheetunahu*) means old and weak, disabled, who have no hope of recovering. It is used for the labourers and workers who usually toil for their livelihood, or the prisoners who do hard work. If such people have difficulty in fasting and cannot offer any amount in compensation either, then they can give up fasting {*Tassawaf-ul-Minar*}.

The next part of this verse is:

2:184	the person who does good work with tolerable hard work it is better for him	فَمَنْ تَطَوَّعَ خَيْرًا فَهُوَ خَيْرٌ لَهُ
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Here the difference between “يُطِيقُونَ” (*yutiqoon*) and “تَطَوَّعَ” (*tatawwa*) must be noted. “يُطِيقُونَ” (*yutiqoon*) means hard work and “تَطَوَّعَ” (*tatawwa*) has the element of obedience, but with some difficulty. See heading (Th-W-Ain).

T e - W - L ط و ل

“طَالَ” (*taal*), “يَطُولُ” (*yatool*), “طَوَّلَ” (*tula*): to be long, elongated {*Tassawaf-ul-Minar*}.

Ibn Faris says “الطَّوْلُ” (*at-tiwal*) means rope because it is long.

20:86	Because a long time has passed, so you think that there is no longer any need to honor the pact which you made with Me?	أَفْطَلْ عَلَيْكُمُ الْعَهْدُ
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“طَوَّلَ” (*taul*): vastness, distance, wellbeing, capacity, power, strength {*T*} (4:25, 40:3).

“تَطَوَّلَ” (*tatawal*): for a long time to pass (28:45).

Surah *Bani Israel* uses the word “طَوَّلَ” (*taula*) to mean the height of a mountain (17:37).

”طَوَى الصَّحِيفَةَ يَطْوِيهَا طَيًّا“ (*tawas saheefatah yatveeha tayya*): he rolled (or wrapped) the paper (papyrus).
 ”طَوَى“ (*ittawa*), ”وَأَنطَوَى“ (*antawa*): he embraced or hugged.

Ibn Faris says this is its basic meaning.

”طَوَى عَنِّي الْحَدِيثَ وَالسِّرَّ“ (*tawa unnil hadeesa wal sir*): he hid the thing or secret from me.

”طَوَى الْبِلَادَ طَيًّا“ (*tawal bilaadi tayya*): he cut the distance between the cities, in other words, wrapped up the roads.

”طَوَى اللَّهُ الْبُعْدَ لَنَا“ (*tawal laahul bu'daalana*): God wrapped up the distance and made it close for us {*T*}.

”الْطَّيَّةُ“ (*at-tiyah*: intent): purpose: the state of being wrapped, the ultimate destination {*M*}.

”طَوَى اللَّهُ عَمْرَهُ“ (*tawal laahu umrah*): God ended his life (reduced his age), wrapped up the duration of his life {*M*}.

The Quran says:

21:104	the day we will wrap up the skies like wrapping up a sheaf of papers	يَوْمَ نَطْوِي السَّمَاءَ كَطَيِّ السِّجْلِ لِلْكَتُبِ
39:27	that day the entire earth will be seized by Allah's laws, and the heavens too will be wrapped up in His authority	وَالْأَرْضُ جَمِيعًا قَبْضَتُهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ وَالسَّمَوَاتُ مَطْوِيَّاتٌ بِيَمِينِهِ

By joining the two concepts together it becomes evident that when a society will come into existence based on the Quranic values, the economic centre with its resources and the permanent values will become the same – i.e. both will be managed by one authority. Presently the capitalist system has a grip on the means of subsistence which is controlled by those who do not believe in the permanent values and this has caused all the human problems of inequality, injustice, poverty, exploitation, etc. After stating this, the Quran has declared that this state cannot continue indefinitely and a system will emerge as noted above.

The next verse states:

39:67	These people who by separating the two (economic resources and the permanent values) commit <i>shirk i.e. create conflicts</i> , Allah is far above and beyond this.	سُبْحَنَهُ وَتَعَالَى عَمَّا يُشْرِكُونَ
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But if ”يوم القيمة“ (*yaumal qiyamah*) is taken to mean the physical end of the world, then ”ارض و سماء“ (*ard o sama'a*) will mean the physical universe.

Surah *Taha* says that when the time to entrust *Moosa* with messenger-hood came, Allah stated God said:

20:14	.. you are at a stage where difference between the human intellect and the divine revelation will be manifested	إِنَّكَ بِالْوَادِ الْمُقَدَّسِ
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The intellectual method to reach the truth or reality is experimental and a long time is required through the process of trial and error before reaching some conclusion. This time may be spread over centuries. This may still not make it possible for the human intellect to discover the truth with certainty with accompanying doubts and suspicion lurking underneath the human reasoning. Contrary to this the revelation wraps up this distance (of trial and error) and shortens it very much by revealing the truth first day as it is e.g. all human beings are equal is a truth and a fact. In *Iqbal's* words, the revelation economizes human efforts. The path of experimentation is long and arduous. The experiments fail and the human effort goes waste and then another experiment is devised which may also fail.. The truth bares itself before a messenger through the revelation. Therefore, messenger-hood means that a messenger does not have to take the long route of experimentation to get to the truth, but instead he is taken to the stage where distances and time are wrapped up (or shortened). This valley or stage has been called ”*tawi*”. The same option is available to us as the Quran is with us as a complete book of guidance.

Raghib has pointed to this meaning as well and also said that if “*tawī*” is joined with “*noudiya*” (which appears in the verse before) then it will mean that **Moosa** was called twice, or that the valley was blessed twice, but these meanings seem unusual.

Te-Y-B

ط ي ب

Raghib says “طَيِّبٌ” (*tayyab*) means a thing which provides pleasure to the human senses as well as his being or personality. In other words, anything which is pleasing to eat, hear, see, smell, as well as be pleasant to his personality, is “طَيِّبٌ” (*tayyab*) to him.

“الْأَطْيَابُ” (*al-atayibu*) and “الْمَطَايِبُ” (*al-mata'yibu*): pleasant and favorite things.

“الطُّوبَى” (*attuba*): it can be the noun as well as the feminine of “طَيِّبٌ” (*atyab*) which means very pleasant life and life of everlasting wellbeing, good luck.

“طَعَامٌ طَيِّبٌ” (*tu-aamun tayyib*): the food which easily goes down the throat (i.e. eaten).

“مَاءٌ طَيِّبٌ” (*ma-un tayyib*): pleasant water.

“الطِّيبُ” (*at-teeb*): fragrance {T}.

“طَابَتِ الْأَرْضُ طَيِّبًا” (*tabatul arzu teeba*): the land became fertile, and grass grew on it {T}. As against it, the word “خَبِيثٌ” (*khabees*) has been used.

The Quran says:

7:58	fertile land grows vegetables according to God's law	وَالْبَلَدُ الطَّيِّبُ يَخْرِجُ نَبَاتَهُ بِإِذْنِ رَبِّهِ
7:58	and the land which is not good, grows very little greenery if at all	وَالَّذِي خَبثُ لَا يَخْرِجُ إِلَّا نَكِدًا

This explains the meanings of “طَيِّبٌ” (*tayyib*) and its opposite i.e. “خَبِيثٌ” (*khabees*). Likewise “شَجَرَةٌ طَيِّبَةٌ” (*shajarah tayyibah*) has been explained as having strong roots in the ground and branches spread out in the air. It bears fruit all year round.

Against it “شَجَرٌ خَبِيثٌ” (*shajarun khabeesun*) is a tree which has shallow roots and can be uprooted by even a slight push (14:24-26).

In surah **Saba**, “بَلَدَةٌ طَيِّبَةٌ” (*baladatun tayyibah*) has been used to mean a city which has lush green gardens to the right and left and which has abundance of sustenance. This shows that when the Quran says “We endow the *momineen* with *hayaatan trayyibah*” it means a life full of pleasantness or a life in which all favorite things are provided to them in abundance. These are the things which please both hearts and senses.

The Quran says that everything in the universe is permitted to be used, except that which has been declared forbidden. But it has added “طَيِّبٌ” (*tayyib*) to the word permitted.

2:168	eat from among the permitted things that are of your favorite	كُلُوا مِمَّا فِي الْأَرْضِ حَلَالًا طَيِّبًا
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This means that aside from the things that the Quran has declared as forbidden, every permitted thing which one favors can be used. This means that nobody can declare a thing as permitted or forbidden, and nobody can force anyone to partake from every permitted thing. If some permitted thing is not liked by someone or if there is some good reason, then it is not necessary for him to eat or use it. A man can eat what he likes from among the permitted things. God has not made any compulsion in this respect and neither should anybody else do so.

“فَعَلْتُ بِطَيِّبَةِ نَفْسِي” (*fa'altu biteebati nafsi*): I have done this of my own free will (without any external coercion) {T}.

Surah **An-Nisaa** says:

4:3	From among the women who have been mentioned earlier, wed which you fancy	فَانكِحُوا مَا طَابَ لَكُمْ مِنَ النِّسَاءِ
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For wedlock, liking and the willingness of the heart is necessary.

4:4	if they willingly forego something in your favor	فَإِنْ طِبْنَ لَكُمْ
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Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:37	such progeny as is cause for blessing for parents	ذُرِّيَّةً طَيِّبَةً
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About the success of the *momineen* it has been said:

13:29	there are every kind of pleasantries for them	طُوبَى لَهُمْ
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This word is very composite and encompasses all the vast blessings of a heavenly society, or *jannat*.

Te-Y-R ط ي ر

“طَارَ” (*taar*), “يَطِيرُ” (*yatiru*), “طَيَّرَانَا” (*tayyaraana*): for a bird to move in air with its wings, to fly (6:38).
 “أَطَارَهُ” (*atara*, “طَيَّرَهُ” (*tayyarahu*): to make fly, to fly with somebody.
 “الطَّيْرُ” (*at-tair*) is the plural of “طَائِرٌ” (*taa-ir*), but is also used to mean singular, as in (3:48). As a plural this word has been used in (67:19).

Ibn Faris says that it basically means for something to be light in the air. Thereafter it is used metaphorically for everything fast.

“اسْتَطَارَ” (*istataar*): for something to be different and scatter {*T*}.
 “الْمُسْتَطِيرُ” (*al-mustateer*): high and scattered, spreading speedily in the air, which has affected the entire atmosphere (76:7).
 “الطَّائِرُ” (*at-taa'iru*): mind. It also means anything which is thought to be lucky or unlucky {*T*}. It may also mean to be an ambitious individual (in righteous sense).

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says that *Isa* told his nation (*Bani Israel*):

3:48	I create for you an imitation of a bird with mud	إِنِّي آخِضُ لَكُمْ مِنَ الطَّيْنِ كَهَيْئَةِ الطَّيْرِ
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But in fact it means that I will create from the same earth (material) a new system in which you will emerge from your present low existence into a higher existence of better life. See heading *Anjeel. Isa* used to explain things by way of allegories and metaphors i.e. using examples from daily life.

“الطَّائِرُ” (*at-taair*) also means bad omen or luck (destructive results) or punishment for deeds {*T*}.
 “الطَّائِرُ” (*at-taairu*) also means luck for the Arabs, but the Quran has used it to mean the result of deeds.

17:13	We have arranged every man's deeds around his neck	كُلُّ إِنْسَانٍ أَلْزَمْنَاهُ طَوْفَهُ فِي عُنُقِهِ
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Here human deeds are called “طَائِرُ” (*tair*) because man has the choice to do it or not to do it; however, he does not have a right to dictate the result of that deed or to escape its effects, or take a deed back after it has been committed. That means that the effects of a deed are out of control and the result of the deed still hangs around his ‘neck’. We cannot be separated from the effects of our deeds – this is the way the law of requital works.

“الْبَاطِرُ” (*at-teerah*): bad luck that is taken to be signified by bad omen.
 “تَطَيَّرْنَا” (*tatayyirna*), “طَائِرُكُمْ” (*tairukum*): he thought it to signify a bad omen {*T*} (36:18-19, 27:47).

In (27:47) it has been said in relation to the beliefs of bad omens. This is the result of your own deeds which has been compiled according to the law of requital devised by Allah, and ‘omen’ does not mean anything.

“فَرَسٌ مُطَارٌ” (*farasun mutaar*), “طَيَّارٌ” (*tayyaar*): intelligent and fast horse {*M*}.

Surah *An-Namal* says that the armies of **Suleman** were constituted of *jinn*, *ins* and *tayir*. *Jinn* means human populations lived in rural area away from established communities, while *Ins* means civilized people, and *tayir* means fast horses (cavalry).

Hence it has been said for **Dawud**, (or David) that he had an army of very fast horses (38:19).

It is about them that **Suleman** had said:

27:16	We were taught the languages of the <i>tayir</i> (literal translation)	عَلَّمْنَا مَنطِقَ الطَّيْرِ
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But it means that we have been trained as how to tame the horses.

Surah *An-Namal* says about **Suleman**:

27:20	And he inspected the <i>tayir</i> and said "How come I am unable to see Hudhud ?"	وَتَفَقَّدَ الطَّيْرَ فَقَالَ مَا لِيَ لَا أَرَى الْهُدْهُدَ
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Here "طَائِرٌ" (*tayir*) has been used to mean speedy steeds (or the cavalry) and **Hudhud** was the name of one of the leaders of the infantry. In those days some of the names of men were given after the birds, like quoted in Torah in the book of *Salateen*.

Lissan-ul-Arab says that **Hudhud** was the name of a tribe in Yemen. Therefore every individual of that tribe was called a *hudhud*, but just as *Qizilbaash* is the name of a tribe, every individual of that tribe is also called a *qizlibaash*.

T e - Y - N ط ي ن

"الطَّيْنُ" (*at-teen*): wet clay or soil {T}.

Raghib says that it means soil mixed with water, even if it nullifies the effect of water. For example, even if it becomes somewhat dry, it will still be called "الطَّيْنُ" (*at-teen*).

"الطَّيْنَةُ" (*at-teenah*): a piece of such mud. It also means a solid type of earth which is used as a seal. Figuratively it also means human instinct {T}. However the Quran has not used the word in this meaning.

Nialabi has said in *Fiqahul Lagha* that when "طِينٌ" (*teen*) dries up it is called "صَلْصَالٌ" (*salsaal*). When it is baked in fire it is called "الْفَخَّارُ" (*al-fakhar*), and when it is sticky like mud it is called "الزَّيْبُ" (*lazaib*).

The Quran says:

32:7	the creation of man began from <i>teen</i>	بَدَأَ خَلْقَ الْإِنْسَانِ مِنْ طِينٍ
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For details see the book titled '*Iblees and Adam*' heading **Insaan**. Also see heading (Sd-L-Sd-L).

When **Isa** proclaimed to his people that "I will turn you into "طَائِرٌ" (*tair*) from "طِينٌ" (*teen*), then it meant "I will extract you from a lowly existence and make you high flying" (3:48) i.e. the guidance from the revelation will develop yourself to an extent that you will turn into different individuals who will have 'life' (8:24). See heading (Te-Y-R).

“طَعَنَ” (*za'un*), “يُطَعِنُ” (*yazun*), “طَعْنًا” (*za'na*): to go on a journey for a purpose, as to look for water, or to search for pastures, or to go from one spring to another or from one city to another.

“طَاعِنٌ” (*zaa-een*): traveler, one who goes on a designated journey.

“الطَّعِينَةُ” (*az-za'eenah*): the ‘howdah’ which contains a woman or a woman herself who is traveling in a howdah (enclosed cabin for the carriage of a female in the old times).

Raghib says “الطَّعِينَةُ” (*az-za'eenah*) signifies a woman even if she is not in a howdah.

“الطَّعُونُ” (*az-za'oon*): a camel which is made ready for a journey {F}.

“الطَّعْنَةُ” (*az-zi'nah*): the state of being in travel {T, M, R}.

Surah *An-Namal* says:

16:80	on the day of a journey (As against <i>aqamah</i> , or to stay foot).	يَوْمَ طَعْنَكُمْ
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“الظُّفْرُ” (*az-zufr*), “الظُّفْرُ” (*az-zufur*): human or animal nail. Some say that herbivorous animals have is

“ظُفْرٌ” (*zufur*) while carnivorous animals have “مِخْلَبٌ” (*mikhlab*), or claw.

“الْأظْفَرُ” (*al-azfar*): having big nails.

“ظَفْرَهُ” (*zafarah*): he dug his nails into his face.

“الظُّفْرَةُ” (*az-zufrah*): a plant which is similar to a nail while starting to emerge from ground {T, M}.

The Quran says:

6:147	And We forbid all animals with hoofs for the Jews This was to punish them for their rebelliousness.	وَعَلَى الَّذِينَ هَادُوا حَرَّمْنَا كُلَّ ذِي ظُفْرٍ حَرَّ يُنْهَمُ بِهِمْ
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There is no mention of “ذِي ظُفْرٍ” (*zi zufur*) among things which have been declared forbidden now in the Quran.

“الظَّفَرُ” (*az-zafar*): to be successful, to get what is desired {T, M, R}.

“الْإِظْفَارُ” (*al-izfaar*): to make success.

Raghib says this meaning has been taken from digging in claws, because a thing in which claws are dug into, comes within a grasp.

Surah *Al-Fatah* says:

48:44	After that, you were made to overwhelm them (made you successful against them)	مِنْ بَعْدِ أَنْ أَظْفَرْنَاهُمْ عَلَيْهِمْ
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Ibn Faris says its basic meanings include anger, success, overpowering and strength.

“الظلُّ” (*az-zill*) with its plural form “ظلالٌ” (*zilaal*) means shade, or the absence of sunlight. Shadow that falls towards west is usually called “ظِلٌّ” (*zill*), that is, the shadow till sunset. The shadow which falls to the east, that is, from the sunset to twilight, is called “فِيءٌ” (*fee'un*) {T}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is for one thing to hide or cover another.

Since Arabia is a hot region and there is a dearth of trees, shade is one of the luxuries of life. Therefore anything luxurious is metaphorically called “ظِلٌّ” (*zill*) {M}. Even the heaven is called “ظِلٌّ” (*zill*), and respect, protection, wellbeing of every kind is also called “ظِلٌّ” (*zill*).

The Quran says:

77:71	Indeed, the righteous ones shall be comfortable	إِنَّ الْمُتَّقِينَ فِي ظِلَالٍ وَعُيُونٍ
4:57	deep shade, deep comfort	ظِلًّا ظَلِيلًا
13:35	its food is everlasting, as well as its comfort	أُكْلُهَا دَائِمٌ وَظِلُّهَا

“الظِّلَّيْ فُلَانُنْ” (*azallani fulanun*): he took me under his wing; he protected me and gave me high respect {T}.

“ظِلٌّ” (*zill*): any place where sunlight does not reach, or anything which covers and protects.

“الظَّلَالُ مِنَ الْبَحْرِ” (*az-zilaalu minal bahr*): the big waves of the sea.

“الظَّلَلُ” (*az-zalalu*): water which is in the shade of trees {T}.

“ظُلَّةٌ” (*zullah*) with its plural “ظُلُلٌ” (*zulal*) means everything which covers {T}. It also means clouds

Raghib says it is used for unhappy times.

About the punishment of the people of *Shoaib* is said:

26:186	The punishment of the day engulfed them when thing which came from above covered them	فَأَخَذَهُمْ عَذَابُ يَوْمِ الظُّلَّةِ
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In other words, it is the day when results of their own deeds overwhelmed them.

“ظَلٌّ يَفْعَلُ كَذَا” (*zallun yaf-ul kaza*): he always kept doing so {M}.

Surah *Ash-Shoora* says that *Ibrahim's* people said:

26:70	We will always keep worshipping these idols	فَظَنُّوا لَهَا عَاقِبَةً
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The Quran says:

16:58	Whenever one of them hears about a girl being born to him, his face turns black (with sorrow or anger)	ظَلَّ وَجْهَهُ مُسْوَدًّا
15:14	If We open kind of a door in the heavens and they climb to it	وَلَوْ فَتَحْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ بَابًا مِنَ السَّمَاءِ فَظَلُّوا فِيهِ يَعْرُجُونَ

Such examples mean that it so happens and will happen so always. That is the reaction that you will always get.

56:55	you will be frustrated	فَظَلُّنَّ تَنَكُّهُنَّ
39:16	flames of fire which may engulf	ظُلُلٌ مِنَ النَّارِ
26:4	their heads will bow before him	فَظَلَّتْ أَعْنَاقُهُمْ لَهَا خَاضِعِينَ

“ظِلٌّ” (*zillun*) has come opposite to heat in (35:21).

Raghib says it means not to keep something in its proper place, either by increasing or decreasing it or removing it from its proper place or time. He says it means to disturb the balance of something {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are of darkness, or by crossing the limits and placing a thing in a wrongful place.

“ظَلَمَ” (*zulm*): to be authoritative in somebody else’s property, to cross a limit. Some say it basically means to make a fault or make less.

“مَظْلَمَةٌ” (*mazlimah*): a thing which is forcibly snatched away.

“الظَّالِمُ” (*az-zaalim*) with its plural forms “الظَّالِمُونَ” (*az-zaalimoona*), “الظَّالِمِينَ” (*az-zaalimeena*), and

“الظَّالِمَةُ” (*az-zalamah*) means those people who usurp others’ rights {*T, M, R*}.

“ظَلَمَ فُلَانًا” (*zalama fulana*): wronged his rights.

“لَمْ تَظْلِمْ مِنْهُ شَيْءًا” (*lam tatlim minhu shai'an*): and they did not usurp it.

“ظَالِمٌ” (*zaalim*) would therefore mean “he who usurps human rights”, or “one who does not pay what is due from him”.

This word is commonly used for not keeping a thing in its proper place. The Arabs use an example:

“مَنْ اسْتَرْعَى الذِّئْبَ فَقَدْ ظَلَمَ” (*manis tar-iz zunbi faqad zalam*): he who thinks a wolf will look after a herd has committed *zulm*. In other words, he did not place the wolf in its rightful place i.e. a wolf will never look after a herd.

“ظَلَمَ الْأَرْضَ” (*zalamal ard*) is said when ground is dug at a place it should not have been dug. This sort of ground is called “مَظْلُومَةٌ” (*muzloomah*), or the one on which *zulm* has been committed.

“ظَلَمَ الْبَعِيرَ” (*zalamal ba-iir*): he slaughtered a camel even though it had no issue or disease.

“ظَلَمَ الْوَادِيَّ” (*zalamal waadi*) means for water to reach where it previously had never reached.

As such, *zulm* would mean to excess and break limits.

“ظَلِمْتُ” (*zalamtahu*): I used it before an appointed time.

“الظَّالِمَةُ” (*az-zaleematu*) and “الْمُظْلُومَةُ” (*al-muzloomah*): milk which is fermented to make yogurt is consumed before it completes the process and turns into yogurt. i.e. not letting it complete its purpose.

“الظُّلْمَةُ” (*az-zulmah*) and “الظُّلْمَةُ” (*az-zulumah*) means darkness. Plural form is “ظُلُمَاتٌ” (*zulmat*).

Raghib says it means for a light to be extinct, i.e. there being no light where there should have been a light

“أَمْرٌ مُظْلِمٌ” (*amrun muzlim*): a matter about which one cannot decide where to get hold from, i.e. ambiguous matter.

“يَوْمٌ مُظْلِمٌ” (*yauma muzlim*): a day in which severe difficulties have to be encountered.

“ظُلُمَاتُ الْبَحْرِ” (*zulumaatil bahr*): difficulties of sea {*T*}.

“شَعْرٌ مُظْلِمٌ” (*sherun muzlim*): jet black hair.

“نَبْتُ مُظْلِمٌ” (*nabtun muzlim*): a plant which is so green that it seems near black in color {*T*}.

The Quran has used “ظَالِمِينَ” (*zalimeen*) often for some of these categories of people:

- who break the laws (the Quranic permanent values),
- transgress and ignore the limits,
- transgress others’ properties,
- do not pay others their dues,
- exploit others’ labor,
- oppress others,
- commit excess on others,
- people who harm their own self-development through these techniques.
- unjust

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:272	That which you keep available from your wealth for the development of others will be returned to you in full and injustice will be done to you	وَمَا تَنْفِقُوا مِنْ خَيْرٍ يُؤْفَ إِلَيْكُمْ وَ أَنْتُمْ لَا تُظْلَمُونَ
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In other words, whatever you have given will not be decreased or lost. Here “لَا تُظْلَمُونَ” (*la tuzlamoon*) has been explained by “يُؤْفَ إِلَيْكُمْ” (*yuwaffa ilaikum*) i.e. will be paid back in full. No injustice will be done further reinforces the value.

Similarly, at another place it is said:

2:281	Then every self will be paid what it had earned, and none shall be wronged.	ثُمَّ تُؤْفَى كُلُّ نَفْسٍ مَا كَسَبَتْ وَهُمْ لَا يُظْلَمُونَ
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Here too “لَا يُظْلَمُونَ” (*la yuzlimoon*) has appeared against “تُؤْفَى” (*tuwaffaa*) – later means to pay back what one is due. This makes things clear.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* gives an example of gardens:

18:33	The (gardens) used to produce fruits in full and made no loss in their produce (i.e. followed laws)	آتَتْ أَكْلَهَا وَهُمْ تَظْلِمُ مِنْهُ شَيْئاً
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Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:229	Those who transgress Allah’s limits (as explained in the Quran) are <i>zaalimoon</i>	مَنْ يَتَعَدَّ حُدُودَ اللَّهِ فَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الظَّالِمُونَ
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This is a very comprehensive definition of *zaalimeen*, because human rights can only be judged according to the Quranic values as Allah has ordained them, and one who breaks these laws usurps human rights. As such, one who breaks Allah’s limits (laws) is a *zaalim* because he does injustice to fellow human rights. At the same time, the Quran tells us that one, who does so, thinks that he is usurping others rights and increasing his own wealth, but in fact he is harming his own self-development. This is clarified in this verse.

3:116	And they wronged their own development	وَلَكِنْ أَنْفُسَهُمْ يَظْلِمُونَ
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By violating the human rights, the balance of a society is also disturbed, and the ones who do it, their own self-development is also affected. In a short run, it may not appear to affect much; however, in the long run the effects show up in the form of crimes, poverty, civil wars, lawlessness, discontentment, etc. That is why the Quran has described *zulm* as evil.

Against it “حُسْنًا” (*husna*) has been used in (27:11), which means the best form of balance and equilibrium.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* uses “ظَلَمْتُ” (*zulumaat*) against “نُورٌ” (*nuur*) in (2:17), which signifies the light of Allah’s revelation. Hence “ظَلَمْتُ” (*zulumaat*) are those concepts, beliefs, and superstitions which human beings hold against the teachings and guidance of the revelation from Allah. The permanent values of the revelation are always the same and do not change with time. That is why “نُورٌ” (*nuur*) (Light) has always appeared as singular but “ظَلَمْتُ” (*zulumaat*) is plural. The truth is always singular, while made up stories of human creation are many.

In verse (2:20), “أَظْلَمَ” (*azlam*) has been used opposite “أَضَاءَ” (*aza’a*). “أَظْلَمَ” (*azlam*) means to become dark and create darkness. It also means to enter darkness. As such, “مُظْلِمُونَ” (*muzlimoon*) would mean those who remain in the dark by choice (36:37).

In surah *Al-Ambia*, the word “ظَلَمْتُ” (*zulumaat*) has been used to mean such difficulties and problems to which there appears to be no solution (21:87).

Surah **Ibrahim** says:

14:34	if man does not follow this guidance and does what he likes, then he usurps the rights of others, and whatever he gets, is kept hidden	إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لَظَالِمٌ كَثِيرٌ
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Instead, the revelation teaches that whatever you earn must also be kept available for mankind at large and nobody's rights must be usurped.

“ظَلَمَ” (*zalloom*): exaggeration, that is, one who oppresses a lot. “ظَلَّمَ” (*zallaam*) also has the same meaning in (3:181).

The purpose of the Quranic teaching is to eradicate *zulm* in all its forms through human efforts from the world and establish a society based on the permanent values.

Ze-M-A ظ م ا

“ظَمِيَ” (*zammīy*), “يَظْمَأُ” (*yazma*), “ظَمَأٌ” (*zam’a*), “ظَمَاءٌ” (*zama*): to be thirsty, or be very thirsty.
 “ظَمِيٌّ” (*zami-un*), “ظَمَانٌ” (*zam’an*): the thirsty one (24:39).
 “ظَمَأٌ” (*zama’a*): thirst (9:120).

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are to wither and be short of water.

About the *jannat* of Adam it is said:

20:118	There you do not feel thirsty (i.e. water is in abundance)	لَا تَظْلَمُونَ فِيهَا
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Only the desert dwellers can understand what importance availability of water is, because their lives depend on it. For them shortage of water is the severest difficulty, and abundance of water is a sign of ‘heavenly’ society. The Quran has pointed to the state of a society based on the permanent values where nobody will have to struggle for basic necessities of life such as food, clothing, shelter, education, support, health, etc. nor is anybody deprived of these (20:118).

“الْظَّمُّ” (*az-zimm*) means the space or duration between drinking or sipping water.

Ze-N-N ظ ن ن

“ظَنَّ” (*zunn*) with tis plural “ظُنُونٌ” (*zunun*) means the stronger of the two uncertain beliefs.
 “ظَنٌّ” (*zunn*) is not evident or clear knowledge.
 True knowledge i.e. one based on facts is called “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*).

Manawi says that “ظَنَّ” (*zunn*) is a belief in which there is some doubt. It is used for uncertain and certain both things. **Lataif-ul-Lagha** supports this and **Ibn Faris** too says these are the two meanings

Raghib says “ظَنٌّ” (*zunn*) is inference. When these indications are strong then this becomes knowledge, and when it is very weak then the result is nothing more than a superstition.

Johri says that sometimes this word is also used for certain knowledge {*T, R*}.

We have seen above that the scholars say that *zunn* means guess and doubt, as well as knowledge and belief, but it is only their guesswork.

The Quran has, as will be seen later, used this term opposite to certainty or truth. Therefore according to the Qurn *zunn* can never mean Truth.

When a matter or issue is not certain (**Raghib** has also noted this), it has two parts. One is sometimes attracted to the truth and sometimes moves away from it, i.e. oscillates between two thoughts. Both these thoughts are called **zunn**.

Raghib also says that if it is followed by “أَنَّ” (**an**) or “أَنَّ” (**anna**) then the leaning is towards certain knowledge and it almost reaches the truth. See examples in the Quran. Also see (2:46), (2:249), and (69:20).

“الظُّنُّونَ” (**az-zanoon**) is a woman who one marries despite her age and there is yet hope for her to bear a child, but not with certainty. It also means a well about which it is not known whether it has water or not. “الَّذِينَ الظُّنُّونَ” (**ad-daynuz-zanon**) also means a loan about which it is doubtful whether the loaner will ever return it or not {**T, M**}.

In the Quran, the word “ظُنُّونَ” (**zunoon**) has been used to mean guesswork.

33:10	And you started guessing in this way about Allah	وَتَظُنُّونَ بِاللَّهِ الظُّنُونَا
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In other words, instead of conviction, your hearts had developed doubts. The conviction in the Quranic Values cannot be developed unless one uses intellect and reasoning to their extremities and then relate and applies to the realities on ground. The Quran has provided guidance on this aspect i.e. how to deal with the doubts and suspicions and convert these into conviction.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** uses **zunn** as against knowledge.

2:78	They know nothing of the book, even when they recite it. They only make guesses (doubtful).	لَا يَعْلَمُونَ الْكِتَابَ إِلَّا أَمَانِيٍّ وَإِنْ هُمْ إِلَّا يَظُنُّونَ
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Surah **An-Nisa** says:

4:157	They have no certain knowledge in this regard, but they only follow guess work.	مَا لَهُمْ بِهِ مِنْ عِلْمٍ إِلَّا اتَّبَاعَ الظَّنِّ
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Surah **Yunus** has used “ظُنُّ” (**zuinn**) against “حَقُّ” (**haqq**):

10:36	zunn cannot benefit at all against haqq (truth)	إِنَّ الظَّنَّ لَا يُغْنِي مِنَ الْحَقِّ شَيْئًا
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The entire structure of **Deen** is built on knowledge and conviction. If we are not sure about some issue as to what is Allah’s direction, then there will exist doubt and uncertainty concerning the solution and our action. Hence **Deen** has to be based on well-established foundations. This is the reason that Allah has declared regarding the protection of the Arabic Text of the Quran. (15:9). This is the very Quran that the Messenger (pbuh) has left for the mankind- fully protected from any human intervention and alteration. Therefore only the Quran provides the truth and the required certainty in **Deen**. Everything else is a guess work. Allah has declared clearly:

10:36	Surely guess-work can be of no avail against Truth	إِنَّ الظَّنَّ لَا يُغْنِي مِنَ الْحَقِّ شَيْئًا
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Whatever is within the Quran is **Deen**. All other which is not in the Quran needs to be verified and checked using the criterion explained in the book before accepting it.

“الظَّنَّةُ” (**az-zinnah**) means uncertain accusation.

“الظَّنِينُ” (**az-zaneen**) is a person with whom the basis of enmity is on a prejudice {**T, M**}.

“الظَّهْرُ مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*az-zahru min min kulli shaiyin*): the outer part of anything as against the internal part, as a man’s back. It also means transport, and also used for abundant wealth which is prominently evident.

“الظَّهْرُ” (*az-zihra*): helper, backer, back up help {T}

“ظَهْرِي” (*zihriyyi’u*): the extra camel which is taken along in case it is needed. Its status is not primary but secondary. Later this word came to mean “to sidetrack somebody” or “ignore somebody”.

“إِتَّكَهَزَ حَاجَتَهُ ظَهْرِيًّا” (*ittakhaza haajatahu zihriyya*): considered his need could be ignored {T}.

“ظَهَرَ الشَّيْءُ” (*zaharash shaiya*): the thing became evident, became prominent, was highlighted and came to the fore {T}.

“ظَهَرَ عَلَيَّ” (*zahara aliyya*): he helped me.

“ظَهَرَ بِيهِ” (*zahara bihi*), “ظَهَرَ عَلَيْهِ” (*zahara alaihi*): overpowered him.

“ظَهَرْتُ الْبَيْتَ” (*zahartul bait*): I climbed on top of a house.

“ظَهَرَ عَلَى السِّرِّ” (*zahara alus sir*): he became aware of the secret.

“أَظْهَرَهُ عَلَيْهِ” (*azharu aliah*): made him overpower him.

“الظُّهْرُ” (*az-zuhr*): afternoon, the time when the sun starts to set or decline. It is derived from “ظَهْرَةُ الشَّمْسِ” (*zaheeratush shams*) which means “extreme heat of the sun”, because at that time it is very hot {T}.

“أَظْهَرَ” (*azhar*): to enter the time of *zuhr* (30:18).

“ظَاهَرَ” (*zaahara*), “تَظَاهَرَ عَلَيْهِ” (*tazaahara alaihi*): helped each other against him.

“الظَّهْرُ” (*az-zaher*): helper. It is used both for singular and plural.

“الظَّهْرُ مِنَ الْمَرْأَةِ” (*az-ziharu minal mar’ah*): the husband saying to the wife “you are like my mother’s back”. The Arabs used to say this in order to break sexual relation with wife (58:2) {T}.

“ظَاهِرُ الْجَبَلِ” (*zaahiru jabal*): the peak of a mountain or its upper part.

“الظَّاهِرَةُ” (*az-zaahirah*): high land {T}, or for something to be prolific.

“ظَهَرَ” (*zahar*): be common and to spread out {R}.

The Quran says:

2:85	You all help each other against them	تَظَاهَرُونَ عَلَيْهِمْ
40:29	the overpowering nation (group) in the country	ظَاهِرِينَ فِي الْأَرْضِ
43:33	Steps which they climb	مَعَارِجَ عَلَيْهَا يَظْهَرُونَ
24:58	heat of the afternoon	ثِيَابِكُمْ مِنَ الظَّهِيرَةِ
33:4	to announce <i>ziuharun</i> about the wife	تُظَاهِرُونَ
24:31	they are not aware of the secret things about women	لَمْ يَظْهَرُوا عَلَى عَوْرَاتِ النِّسَاءِ
72:26	He does not tell anyone about His hidings	فَلَا يُظْهِرُ عَلَى غَيْبِهِ أَحَدًا
2:189	from behind the house (against back yard)	مِنْ ظُهُورِهَا
24:30	let them not exhibit their adornments: excepting those which are self-evident	وَلَا يُبْدِينَ زِينَتَهُنَّ إِلَّا مَا ظَهَرَ مِنْهَا
24:31	and let them not walk with a heavy tread lest whatever they have as adornments are known to others	وَلَا يَضْرِبْنَ بِأَرْجُلِهِنَّ لِيُعْلَمَ مَا يُخْفِينَ مِنْ زِينَتِهِنَّ

These two last verses refer to jewelry which is worn on the calves and which is commonly hidden and is used by women in various cultures in the past less so now. To make it evident, one stamps on the ground or walks forcefully so that it makes a sound. As far as the jewelry which is worn on the upper part of the body, it is said:

24:31	Let them put their shawls over their bosoms	وَلْيَضْرِبْنَ خُمْرَهُنَّ عَلَى جُيُوبِهِنَّ
33:59	They must have a cloth as overall or as an overcoat.	يُدْنِينَ عَلَيْهِنَّ مِنْ جَلَا يُبِينَ

These adornments are to remain hidden from outsiders, not from their own folks (24:31). The things which are self-evident are the rings or bangles, or any jewelry put in the nose. The hands and the nose remain exposed even with an overall or shawl. The Quran has not asked women to cover them. It has

instead directed both men and women to lower their eyes (gaze) and not allow them to be brazen (24:30-31). It is evident therefore that the Quran has no intention for women to hide their faces, because if women hide their faces then there is no need for men (and women) to keep their eyes lowered.

These are the instructions of the Quran about display of adornments and can be understood rationally. Things which display themselves or which are self-evident have not been asked to be covered.

Surah *Hoodh* says that *Shoaib* told his nation:

11:92	you have merely kept God as Zahira	وَاتَّخَذْتُمُوهُ وَرَاءَكُمْ ظَهْرًا
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This means, for you the actual importance is for your own decisions and man-made laws, but you keep Allah's revelation as a backup, so this may be of some use in cases of your choice if required. Note how this is event now prevalent in the Islam being practiced by various sects i.e. the Quran is used when suits to be quoted otherwise ignored as a book of guidance!

In surah *Al-Hadeed* an attribute of Allah has been mentioned as “الظَّاهِرُ” (*az-zaahiru*) (57:3). Here “الظَّاهِرُ” (*az-zaahiru*) does not mean the one who can be seen with the naked eye, because when *Bani Israel* had demanded to see Allah with their own eyes (2:55), they were told that their desire was childish because Allah cannot be seen by humans. Therefore “الظَّاهِرُ” (*az-zaahiru*) in (57:3) means the being on whose existence many visible things of the universe are a testimony. It may also mean the one who overwhelms everything, but His overpower works unfeelingly, i.e. unseeingly, because along with being “الظَّاهِرُ” (*az-zaahiru*), He is also “الْبَاطِنُ” (*al-baatin*), or hidden (57:3). Allah can only be ‘visible’ through His creation. This does not mean that creations are Allah themselves. The sense is that these creations signify the presence of their creator (*ayaat Allah*) i.e. serve as a sign. The laws of Allah permeate through everything i.e. which everything follows in the universe. That is evidence of His authority. This is how Allah is “الظَّاهِرُ” (*az-zaahior*), but nobody can know how or what Allah is. This way, He is “الْبَاطِنُ” (*al-baatin*). According to His laws, His authority is in the universe but not imprisoned in it. The virtue of His personality is above everything in the universe but not separate from the universe. He is “الظَّاهِرُ” (*az-zaahir*) and “الْبَاطِنُ” (*al-baatin*) at the same time, i.e. He is simultaneously immanent and transcendent. He has a personality but not personified. His authority is Divine Energy but not without a personality.

In *Arabia* and neighboring areas like *Syria*, *Iraq* etc. the nations of *Saamia* were scattered. The most important nation among them was that of *Aad*, which on one side had spread from *Haza maut* and *Yemen* to *Iraq* along the Gulf of Persia. On the other, it had gone out of *Arabia* to rule *Syria* and *Egypt*. About 2500 BC this nation seems to be the ruling power in these areas. They are also known as *Aad-e-Irum* after *Aad's* son *Irum*.

The Quran has called them the successors of the nation of *Nooh* (7:69). This shows that they were an ancient nation. Messenger *Hoodh* was sent to this nation. The place of his teachings and preaching was the area of *Ahqaaf*, which means winding sand dunes and desert. The vast Arabian Desert which was called *Ahqaaf* is now called *Ruba khaali*.

The Quran says that according to those times, this nation had abundance of life's achievements. There were springs of water everywhere, gardens full of fruit laden trees, abundance of progeny and cattle (26:132-134). They used to build big buildings at every highway (26:128). They also had knowledge and perception (46:26), but their selfish interests had put them on the wrong path and their knowledge and perception were not used in righteous deeds (29:38). Messenger *Hoodh* warned them about their wrong deeds, but they paid no heed and ignored his warning. They were later engulfed by a storm which destroyed them (69:6-8). They have been called *The first Aad* by the Quran (53:50). Those few who had believed in *Hoodh's teachings* were saved and their progeny as descendants followed and were called *The second Aad*.

Details as to the link between the deeds of this nation and their destruction through natural calamity can be found in the book titled *Jooyi Noor*.

Ain-B-A

ع ب ا

“الْعَبْءُ” (*al-ibb*): burden, load, weight, goods etc.

“مَا عَابَأْتُ بِهِ” (*ma abaatu bihi*): for me it has no weight (burden as well), I do not care about it {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

25:77	What weight (significance) do you hold before my Sustainer? {F}	مَا يَغْبُرُ بِكُمْ رَبِّي
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Ain-B-Th

ع ب ث

“الْعَبَثُ” (*al-abas*): any deed which has no clear direction, or the benefit or use of which is not known. It is used for a person who does not know why he is doing something. In other words, it means to do something without fixing a purpose for carrying out an action or activity. This is why games are called “عَبَثُ” (*abas*) {*T, M, R*}.

“عَبَثَ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*abusa bish-shaiyi*): mixed it with something to adulterate it {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is to mix something with the intention to adulterate it.

When a man does something with a purpose in mind, he does not mix it with any work which does not lead towards that purpose. But if no purpose is ascertained, then as we pass time in our life anything can interfere with it as we will not be aware of its consequences.

“عَبِثَتِ النَّاسُ” (*abeesatun naas*): people of different tribes who do not have a common ancestry.

“الْعَبِثَةُ” (*al-abeesah*): mixed herd of goats.

“الْعَبَثُ” (*al-abus*): work which is non-beneficial, work which does not have a definite aim and purpose {*T, M, R*}.

According to the Quran, this entire universe, and everything in it, has been created with a purpose, and the purpose according to the Quran is to hold human beings accountable for their deed as stated in (45:21). The right path is that which leads an individual to do righteous deeds as explained in the Quran and as a consequence be able to develop his self. Those who do not believe in this accountability, their view is that this universe has come into being on its own without any purpose. Therefore they live a life which is not based on the permanent values of the Quran and this aspect has also been referred in the Quran in detail.

Whole edifice of life is built on these two separate concepts of life i.e. accountability as explained in the Quran and absence of accountability and its consequences also explained in the Quran. The explained has referred to both the concepts of life in detail and detailed the consequences as well. This is why the Quran is a complete book of guidance.

In order to highlight this very difference, the Quran has said:

23:115	do you think that We have created you without a definite purpose and meaning	أَفَحَسِبْتُمْ أَنَّمَا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ عَبَثًا
21:16	We have not created the universe as a sport	وَمَا خَلَقْنَا السَّمَاءَ وَالْأَرْضَ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا لَعِبٍ

See also (44:37) where instead of “السماء” (*asma*) i.e. Universe it is said “السموات” (*as-samawaat*) which means **Universes**. It means that there is a definite purpose for the creation of this human life. As stated earlier the creation is with a programme and is based on ‘haqq’ or truth (44:38). The universe is created with an aim to produce constructive results.

Just to illustrate with an opposite concept of life, for example according to the Hindu philosophy this entire universe is '*ram leelah*' or a play for the gods. In other words, a drama staged by God in which He Himself plays the biggest role, and that is why He is also called '*nat rajan*' or the king of players.

The Quran has refuted such like concepts and has stressed the reality and seriousness of this life. As per this philosophy, all those things that happen during a person's lifetime without any proper planning hold no value with Him. One of the crimes the Quran relates about the nation of *Aad* which was destroyed, is that they used to build great buildings so that they would serve as monuments. As such, it has compared this to “تَعْبَثُونَ” (*ta'basoon*) in (26:128) i.e. waste of effort. That is, there must be some purpose or benefit of a building or construction. Building a great monument which has no practical value is a waste of time and effort.

Same is happening all over the world including the Muslims who read the Quran regularly and pay little attention to its values. Any construction which has no value for the mankind at large will not find support from the Quran. In this context, any deed of human beings that is not beneficial to humans at large is useless (2:177). Also see (18:103-106). In this context see headings (Th-W-B), (L-Ain-B) and (S-D-Y).

Ain-B-D ع ب د

“عَبْدٌ” (*abad*) actually means a scented plant that holds a lot of attraction for camels. Camels get corpulent if they eat it and also start to give more milk. This plant also produces thirst when camels eat it and need water to drink. As such, this plant holds three characteristics of attraction, producing thirst, which finally produce corpulence and abundance of milk. Therefore its connotation holds initial pain, but ultimate success and comfort. In the same way the Arabs used to rub fat on their boats which made the boats look ugly, but ultimately the boats were kept safe from the effects of water. Therefore the boat was called “سَفِينَةٌ مُّعَبَّدَةٌ” (*safinatoon mu-abeydah*).

Ibn Faris has included two meanings as basics for this word, i.e. softness and harshness. Here he refers to the sort of softness which in fact later produces resilience.

According to this basic meaning “عِبَادَةٌ” (*ibadat*) which means to do some deed with heartfelt inclination and which as per its ultimate results is very beneficial even if initially it requires hard work and persistent effort.

2:286	On no self Allah places a burden greater than it can bear...	لَا يَكْلِفُ اللَّهُ نَفْسًا إِلَّا وُسْعَهَا
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In following the Quran one accepts some bindings on himself which may appear difficult initially but in the long run these hold many benefits and these limits in fact make the character stronger with passage of time. The Quran fully explains the consequences of following the values and their significance.

The Quran has made this meaning clear in three verses where the messenger is being told to:

51:55	continue presenting the Quran Guidance to people because this will benefit those who accept it	وَذَكِّرْ فَإِنَّ الذِّكْرَى تَنْفَعُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ
51:56	We have created mankind whether urban or rural to follow the divine guidance (<i>It may appear challenging initially, but is beneficial in the long term</i>)	وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ
51:57	(and remember) We do not wish any sustenance or reward from them (<i>for following the Divine Guidance</i>) . Their hard work [<i>in following the Guidance</i>] is for their own benefit	مَا أُرِيدُ مِنْهُمْ مِنْ رِزْقٍ وَمَا أُرِيدُ أَنْ يُطْعِمُونِ

In other words, initially there are hardships as the system is established by individuals accepting the guidance and then making efforts to create a system. There is a strong opposition from those who do not wish to give up their privileges; however, if efforts are continued then the system gets established and all the promised benefits are reaped by everyone.

In order to understand this term “عَبْدٌ” (*abbad*) we need to keep both aspects of difficulties and benefits in mind, which we confront in our life. For example the term “تَعْبِيدٌ” (*ta'beed*) means when a horse is trained enough to harness it for riding. This is called harnessing or breaking of a horse. The term also means to make a road level and smooth, so that people can use it for going from one place to another. The point to note here is that initially all these tasks involve hard work , but later these provide long term benefits. Applying this analogy to the Quranic Guidance means that the values explained in the book will provide long term benefits to anyone who follows it using human intellect and reasoning .

Thus the true meaning of “عِبَادَةٌ” (*ibadat*) is to recognize the need for the Quranic Guidance through free volition and then using our intellect and reasoning to accept it with conviction. The firm conviction in what is stated in the Quran is Truth and that what is being promised is achievable through human efforts. It then becomes a proper programme to educate and train all volunteers in the guidance with a view to work jointly to establish a system for the good of mankind (2:151). This requires time, effort and resources which these volunteers acquire and spend through their free volition as they have developed this infinite conviction that what is in the Quran is Truth from Allah – the Creator of the Universes (9:111).

The Quran declares:

16:36	Be obedient to Allah and do not transgress the defined limits	اعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ وَاجْتَنِبُوا الطَّاغُوتَ
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The meaning of “طَّاغُوتٌ” (*taghoot*) is all those forces which work against the permanent values e.g. exploitation, slavery, conflicts, wars, etc. Therefore this this verse would mean that harness your own abilities and external forces of nature according to the guidance of the Quran and utilize these for the good of mankind so that your this part of life and the next part of life are successful (2:201).

At another place it is said:

19:44	Do not obey <i>shaitaan</i>	لَا تَعْبُدِ الشَّيْطَانَ
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The meaning of “شَّيْطَانٌ” (*shaitaan*) is the same as explained earlier i.e. the forces which follow human desires and do not accept the permanent values of the Quran.

19:44	Indeed, <i>shaitaan</i> is disobedient to Rahman	إِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ كَانَ لِلرَّحْمَنِ عَصِيًّا
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The *shaitaan* referred here is the human desires which can never guide to the righteous path and need the Quranic guidance – the attribute of Allah referred here is *Rehman*. See heading (R-H-M). Also See heading (Sh-Te-N).

Also see those verses of the Quran in which it is said:

45:23	Have you not seen him who has made his own desires his god?	أَفَرَأَيْتَ مَنِ اتَّخَذَ إِلَهَهُ هَوَاهُ
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The full verse of Surah *An-Nahal* given above is as follows:

16:36	Every messenger who came with the message from Allah exhorted people to accept Allah's mission and avoid falsehood	وَلَقَدْ بَعَثْنَا فِي كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ رَسُولًا أَنِ اعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ وَاجْتَنِبُوا الطَّاغُوتَ
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Thus this makes the meaning of being “*abad* of Allah” clear, because at another place it is said:

4:60	consider the condition of those who in their own minds think that they believe in the Quran and other holy books prior to it	وَيُرِيدُونَ أَن يُتَحَكَّمُوا إِلَى الطَّاغُوتِ وَقَدْ أُمِرُوا أَن يَكْفُرُوا بِهِ
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They still want all their problems to be solved through ungodly means or laws although they have been ordered to avoid such ungodly laws (2:257). As such it is clear that avoiding “*طَّاغُوتُ*” (*taghoot*), or the ungodly, means that man should solve his problems neither according to his personal thoughts and desires, nor through ungodly means and laws, but through laws that have been made and revealed by Allah. It is this that has been called “*أَعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ*” (*abaidullah*), that is, to adopt the way of Allah as this is the right Quranic meaning of performing “*عِبَادَةُ*” (*ibadat*) of Allah. The Quran has used the term “*أَعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ*” (*abaidullah*) exactly in the way the word “government” is used nowadays.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says at one place:

18:110	They should not include anyone else in their <i>abad</i> of their Rabb (Sustainer)	وَلَا يُشْرِكْ بِعِبَادَةِ رَبِّهِ أَحَدًا
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At another place it is said about Allah:

18:26	He does not include or let anyone share in His authority	وَلَا يُشْرِكْ فِي حُكْمِهِ أَحَدٌ
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In the same way it is said in Surah *Yusuf* that:

12:40	there can be no authority but that of Allah He has ordered not to accept subservience of any other	إِنِ الْحُكْمُ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ أَمْرًا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِلَاهَ
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Thus we see how the Quran has used the words authority, government, sovereign, and *ibadah*.

In the narrative covering the messenger *Moosa* he tells Pharaoh that his favors to him when he was a child were of no consequence as compared to keeping the Bani Israel under subjugation. The Quran then quotes the people of Pharaoh:

23:47	(Shall we accept what these two brothers are telling us who are nothing but human beings like us, and) when even their people are our slaves?	وَقَوْمُهُمَا لَنَا عَابِدُونَ
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The Quran makes it very clear that if we wish to benefit in this life and the next then we have only one option i.e. to follow the permanent values as revealed. Allah has declared:

5:44	The people who do not carry out their affairs as per the revelation given by Allah (as contained in the Quran) are a people who reject the guidance (therefore cannot benefit from it)	وَمَنْ لَّمْ يَحْكَمْ بِمَا أَنزَلَ اللَّهُ فَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْكَافِرُونَ
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This is the reason that the Quran has declared clearly that the believers will only be given authority if they will establish Deen (24:55) and this will include:

(1) the permanent values are followed (2) no other law is followed.

From the above it becomes clear that “عِبَادَةٌ” (*ibadat*) does not mean worship as practiced in various sects as this type of worship can be carried out under any form of government which has nothing to do with the Quran.

The historical background to this term is that when the oppressed under any oppressive and dictatorial regimes were reprieved, they were called “عَبِيدٌ” (*abeed*). “عَبِيدٌ” (*abeed*), and “عِبَادٌ” (*ibaad*) are the plural of “عَبْدٌ” (*abad*). The plural of “عَابِدٌ” (*abid*) is “عَابِدُونَ” (*abidoon*) and “عَبْدَةٌ” (*abadah*), but the feeling of sympathy for such relieved persons or “عَبِيدٌ” (*abeed*) did not last very long and the people who were freed from the oppressive regime began to be turned into slaves again. As such, the word “عَبِيدٌ” (*abeed*) acquired the connotation of being ruled or subservient. As such, the meaning of “عَابِدٌ” (*abid*) in the Quran came to mean the subservient or the ruled (23:27), and “عَبَّدَ” (*abbad*) came to mean “to make subservient” (26:22), and “عَبْدٌ” (*abad*) came to mean slave, or subordinate (2:178).

This has given the connotation of obedience. As such, “تَعَبَّدَ” (*ta’abbud*) and “تَذَلَّلَ” (*tazallul*) are used in the same meaning, i.e. to submit before the laws of Allah. This is the emotion that is inherent in worship, and thus “عِبَادَةٌ” (*ibadah*) has come to mean worship

The Quran says:

26:71	they said we worship idols	قَالُوا نَعْبُدُ أَصْنَامًا
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These idols are manifestation of the images present in the minds of these worshippers as beliefs and consequently they associate benefits and harms with these beliefs. Therefore these idols are worshipped either in expectation of favors or fear. These beliefs establish firm inner hold on these followers and become so well established over a period of time that these provide emotive satisfaction within a group. Since group benefits are associated with having common beliefs even if wrong, majority never questions it and these continue from generations to generations. The Quran has referred to this state of affairs in many places e.g. (53:23), (43:23). This is also the basis on which any subservience is undertaken.

With reference to the initial hard work, the same matter gives rise to “عَبِدَ يَعْبُدُ” (*abida ya’budu*) which means to express hatred or frustration. As such Surah *Az-Zakhrif* says:

43:81	if there can be a <i>Rehman</i> (Attribute of Allah) who can have children then I shall be the first to disapprove Him	قُلْ إِنْ كَانَ لِلرَّحْمَنِ وَلَدًا فَأَنَا أَوَّلُ الْعَابِدِينَ
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In other words, since there is no question of any son being born to Allah, therefore there can be no question of any acceptance of this position. Now if “أَبِيدٌ” (*abideen*) is to be considered as derived from “عَبْدٌ” (*abad*), then this verse could also mean that if Allah had a son, then I would have been the first to obey this son, but since this can never be the case, I do not accept this. This whole argument is baseless as it is our self, which is based on our thought process actually defines us as humans, and this we cannot pass it on to our progeny i.e. what defines human self is non-physical and is not governed by the physical laws. The Quran puts repeated emphasis on the acceptance of the revelation as an external standard to manage human affairs based on the permanent values and states that this is a human world and humans have the free will to make their own choices. There is no short cut to this process and this is only possible if we first understand the Quran the way Allah wishes us to understand it. This is all explained in the Quran and this invitation is for all human beings for all times.

“الْعَبْدُ” (*al-abad*) means a human being whether he is free or a slave. Later this word began to be used to mean slave.

To summarise this discussion in relation to this term:

1) Wherever **ibadat** of Allah is mentioned, it will mean to follow the Quran with full acceptance with the full use of human intellect and reasoning. This will bring the inner conviction and one would be able to see the benefits associated with following the guidance. In the process of establishing a system some form of expressing collective emotion in a gathering e.g. to say common prayer to physically demonstrate our desire to follow Allah's laws is mentioned in the Quran. However, to think that it is an end itself, is against the teaching of the Quran and when looked at logically can never be the case, as such gatherings for prayers as we see these, do not solve any human issues as required by following the permanent values. For details, see the topic of **salat** which comes under the heading (Sd-L-W). The bowing and bending before Allah means that we submit ourselves before the laws of Allah, and we accept willfully the laws of Allah. The Quranic guidance is about solving human issues within the permanent values with only one authority i.e. Allah – no human model and this is what means real freedom.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says “أَسْلَمْتُ” (**aslamtu**) and “تَعَبُدُ” (**na'budu**) to mean the same thing. It is this that has been called the way of life (2:131-133) plus the words “مُسْلِمُونَ” (**muslimoon**), “عَابِدُونَ” (**abidoon**) and “مُخْلِصُونَ” (**mukhlisoon**) have also been used in this meaning (2:136-138).

2) Wherever “طَاغُوتَ” (**taghoot**) or falsehood is mentioned it would mean man's faithfulness to his own desires or following the orders of other human beings. This obedience will include the loyalty to the oppressive regimes and will also include the teachings of so-called religious leaders. On the contrary Allah's 'worship' would mean following the laws of Allah and of none else.

3) Wherever **ibadat** of gods and goddesses is mentioned, it would mean the superstitious worship of these idols. Faithfulness to them is the same as bowing before kings and queens.

4) “عِبَادُ الرَّحْمَنِ” (**ibadur rahman**) would only mean those people who follow the laws of Allah. These are those who devote all their energies and abilities as directed by the Quran This makes the meaning of “إِيَّاكَ” (**iyaka na'budu**) clear, i.e. “We only perform your **abad**”, or that “We only bow before your laws and obey them, and devote all our energies and abilities in the way that you have ordained for us”.

To rise and bend collectively in traditional prayer is the manifestation of these emotions of being faithful towards Allah, but Allah's **ibadat** is not confined to this form of worship only. **Ibadat** of Allah means to follow His laws with every breath and in every aspect of our lives.

51:56	And I have created Jinn and Ins so they may only obey me.	وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ
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It must also be highlighted here that through following or obeying Allah's laws, man is able to enjoy heavenly bliss on this earth and it makes him capable of rising to new heights of evolution in the world hereafter. Thus this 'governance' or 'obedience' enables man to self-impose the higher values of life over oneself. As said earlier, these are self-imposed restrictions and are not imposed by any external compulsion. Also that **ibadat** here does not mean the sort of worship that the prehistoric man, who was afraid of nature's forces, imposed upon himself in order to please those forces.

“عَبَرَ” (*abara*) means to reach another place or state.

“عَبَرَ النَّهْرَ” (*abaran nahar*): he crossed a canal, i.e. he reached from one bank of a canal to other bank.

“عَبَرَ السَّبِيلَ” (*abaras sabeel*): he reduced the distance or traversed it.

“الْمُعْبَرُ” (*al-mebar*): the means through which he crossed the canal, like a boat or bridge etc.

According to this theory *Raghib* says that “عِبَارَةٌ” (*ibarah*) means the sentence that travels from one’s mouth and reaches another’s ear.

“عِبْرَةٌ” (*ibrah*) is the understanding which one has through observation about some unseen conclusion or result.

“إِثْبَارُ الشَّيْءِ” (*itabarash shaiyee*): to evaluate something thoroughly and to decide about it by bringing some example of that thing to fore.

“التَّعْبِيرُ” (*at-tabeer*): to interpret a dream. This word is also used to make the verbs such as “عَبَرَ” (*abara*), “يُعْبَرُ” (*ya’bur*), “عَبْرًا” (*abran*) and “عِبَارَةٌ” (*ibarah*) etc.

Ibn Faris has presented a saying from *Khalil* which says “عَبَّرْتُ الدَّنَا نِيرَتُعْبِيرًا” (*abbartu dananeera tabeera*) which means to weigh or evaluate each dinar.

To mean interpretation of a dream, this word has been used in (12:23).

“عِبْرَةٌ” (*ibratun*) has been used in (16:66).

59:2	The people of understanding will take heed of the presenting evidence with a view to	فَاعْتَبِرُوا يَا أُولِيَ الْأَبْصَارِ
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“عَبَرَ السَّبِيلَ” (*abaras sabeel*): cutting short or reducing the distance, has led to “عَابِرِي سَبِيلٍ” (*aabiri sabeel*) as in (2:23), which means “those who cross or travel the distance”.

“عَبَسَ وَجْهَهُ” (*abus wajuhu*): he distorted his face.

“عَبَسَ تَعْبِيسًا” (*abbasa ta’beesa*) also means the same as above.

“الْعَبَّاسُ” (*al-abbas*): a man who has a permanent crease on his forehead.

“الْعَبْسُ” (*al-abus*) means excrement and urine that sticks to a camel’s tail and dries up {*T*}.

The Quran says:

74:22	he then creased his brow (or frowned, or distorted his face)	ثُمَّ عَبَسَ
76:10	a day whose brow is severely creased (a horrific day, a day whose harshness distorts people’s faces)	يَوْمًا عَبُوسًا قَمْطَرِينًا

Raghib says that it means distortion of a face because of adverse inner emotive state of an individual {*R*}.

“عَبْقَرٌ” (*abqar*) was a dwelling place in the desert which the Arabs believed was habituated by *Jinns*. Whenever they saw something unique or strange, they associated it with the dwellers of “عَبْقَرٌ” (*abqar*), i.e. with Jinn, or strangers.

Ibn Syedah says it was the name of a habitation in a city in Yemen which was famous for its engraving of the floors and fancy clothes. Thus whenever beauty and fineness of a work was meant, it was linked to this city. Later “الْعَبْقَرِيُّ” (*al-abqari*) came to mean a complete, unusual and best thing, as well as a tribal chief or high ranking person.

Fara says it means very good and thick floor {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran has said:

55:76	beautiful and unique floors	عَبْقَرِيٌّ حَسَانٍ
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Ibn Faris says it basically means hardness and difficulties.

“الْعَتَبَةُ” (*al-atabah*): the thresh hold of a door.

“الْعَتَبَةُ” (*al-atabah*): Stubbornness or hardness in some matter, or very unpleasant thing.

“الْعَتَبُ” (*al-atab*): hard and stony ground {*T, M*}. It also means land which is not favorable for someone who wished to be there {*R*}.

“الْعَتْبُ” (*al-atab*): a camel walking on three legs whose one leg is injured or tied. It is also used for a man who hops around on one leg.

“تَعَتَّبَ عَلَيْهِ” (*ta-attaba alaih*): he became angry with someone.

“الْتَعَا تَبٌ” (*at-ta'aatubu*) and “الْمُعَا تَبَةٌ” (*al-mu'atabnah*): to relate mutual anger and displeasure {*T, M*}.

“عَتَبَاتٌ” (*atabaat*): steps of a ladder, as well as steps of rocky stairs.

“عَتَبَةٌ” (*atabaah*): thresh hold of a door as it is higher than its surroundings.

“الْعُتْبَى” (*al-otbah*): agreement or willingness.

“اِسْتَعْتَبَهُ” (*ista'tabahu*): wanted his willingness and pleasure. It also means that he gave up his displeasure and agreed with him {*T, M*}.

“قَدْ اَعْتَبَيْتَنِي فُلَانٌ” (*qad a'tabini fulan*): He gave up all such issues which had earlier displeased me, and hence he gained my friendship

“اِلِسْتِعْتَابٌ” (*ill isti'taab*): demand or ask for an agreement, or to ask pardon, or to ask somebody to give up his displeasure and anger.

“الْمُعْتَبُ” (*al-mo'tab*): the one who has been made to agree, the one from whom anger is removed {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

41:24	If they want to give up things which have brought them ignominy and punishment and thus seek our pleasure, then they will not be able to do so	وَ اِنْ يَسْتَغِيثُوا فَمَا هُمْ مِنَ الْمُعْتَبِينَ
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Ignominy and punishment will not leave them, as they will not be pardoned. Also see (16:84).

“عَتِيدٌ” (*ateed*): ready, present, near {*T*}.

“اَعْتَدَ” (*a'tad*): to make ready, to prepare, to keep present (50:18) {*T*}.

Raghib says it means to stock pile things of need beforehand (4:18) {*R*}.

Since *jahannam* (Hell i.e. consequences of one's deeds) - it comes into existence (though invisible initially) as soon as one starts doing wrong deeds.

The Quran says:

4:18	a painful punishment has been prepared for them	أَعْتَدْنَا لَهُمْ عَذَابًا أَلِيمًا
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It is not a something prepared by Allah in advance. It means, as mentioned earlier, that a man starts preparing his *jannat (paradise)* and *jahannam(hell)* with every step he takes in his/her life, and all this happens according to the law of requital created by Allah. For details see heading *Jahannam* where it has been explained that even today *jahannam* is before us and near to every individual committed to doing wrong.

According to *Ibn Faris* this root's basic meanings are nearness and presence.

Ain-T-Q ع ت ق

“الْعَتِيقُ” (*al-itq*): independence, freedom, high descent, respect, beauty.
 “عَتَقَ الْعَبْدُ يَعْتِقُ” (*ataq al-abdu ya'tiq*): the slave won his freedom.
 “اتِيقُنْ” (*atiquun*) or “عَاتِقٌ” (*at-iqun*) is a slave who gains his freedom {T}.

The Quran calls the *Kaba* as “” (*bait-ul ateeq*) in (2:29), i.e. the center of Allah's system which is free of all slavery and subjugation, which is not affected by anything, physical or mental.
Kitaabal Ashqaaq supports these above meanings.

As a symbol this places it very high if it represents freedom from all types of slavery and the nation which owns it will have a very high status in the community of mankind.

“رَاحَ عَتِيقٌ” (*raahun ateeq*): that wine whose seal is unbroken, in other words old (vintage) wine.
 “عَتَقَ الْفَرَسُ عَتَقًا” (*ataq al-farsu itqa*): the horse galloped ahead {T}.
 “عَتِقٌ” (*itq*) means strength in the dictionary {M}.

Ibn Faris says this root is used to mean (1) to be respectable (2) and to be old (antique).

Raghib says “الْعَتِيقُ” (*al-ateeq*) means predecessor with regard to time, or place or rank. Therefore for K'aba to be “الْبَيْتُ الْعَتِيقُ” (*beitul ateeq*) includes all connotations for it to be free, powerful, according to time and space and ahead of all others. This represents the rank of Muslim nation, because K'aba is merely a symbol of Allah's system as well as the center of its nation, just as a capitol or a flag are symbols of a country. The respect of a flag means the respect of the country that it represents as a symbol.

As far as the *Kaba* being ahead in time is concerned, it means that it came into being (as the Centre of the people of *Ibrahim- who was Muslim*) long before the center of the Jews and Christians (*Baitul Muqaddas*) did.

Ain-T-L ع ت ل

“الْعَتْلَةُ” (*al-atalatah*): an iron rod which is broader at one end (sort of a crow bar). It is used to dig or demolish a ground or a wall. It is also used for cutting branches of a date palm.

“الْعَتْلُ” (*al-atal*) means to drag somebody very harshly, cruelly or to use excessive force.
 “أَخَذَ بِزِمَامِ السَّاقَةِ فَعَتَلَهَا” (*akhaza bi zamaam as-saaqatih fa'atalaha*): he caught a camel's reins and pulled it very cruelly.
 “هُوَ مَعْتَلٌ” (*huwa mi-u'tal*): he has the power to pull cruelly.

Ibnul Sakeet has said that “عَتْلَةٌ” (*atalahu*) means to push someone very harshly or to pull someone very cruelly towards a prison.

Raghib says this means to hold someone where many of his parts conjoin and pull it with force.

Ibn Faris says it basically means intensity and strength.

Surah *Ad-Dukhaan* says:

44:47	pull him towards the <i>Jahannam</i>	فَأَعْتَلُوهُ إِلَىٰ سَوَاءِ الْجَحِيمِ
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“أَعْتَلُ” (*al-utul*): one who eats a lot and who saves on wealth (who is miserly with wealth). It means one who abstains from good deeds, or one who is very quarrelsome {T}. Being cruel or harsh are meanings included in the connotation.

The Quran says:

68:13	Violent and cruel with all that base born	عُتُلٌ بَعْدَ ذَٰلِكَ زَنِيمٌ
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For the meaning of “زَنِيمٌ” (*zaneem*), see heading (Z-N-M).

ع ت و Ain-T-W

“عَتَا” (*ata*), “يَعْتُو” (*ya’tu*), “عَتِيَّا” (*itriyya*), “عُتُوًّا” (*utuwwa*): to transgress a defined limit, to disobey a rule.
 “عَتَّتِ الرِّيحُ” (*atatir reeh*): the wind increased in its intensity, i.e. it turned into a storm {T}.
 “لَيْلٌ عَاتٍ” (*lailun aat*): very dark night {T}.
 “مَلِكٌ عَاتٍ” (*malikun aat*): very cruel and heartless king {M}.

Surah *Al-Haqqah* says about the nation of *Aad*:

69:6	they were killed by strong wind (storm)	فَأَهْلَكُوهُمُ رِيحٌ صَرْصَرٍ عَاتِيَةٍ
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Surah *At-Talaq* says:

65:8	Rebellion against the Sustainer (who nurtures him).	عَتَّتْ عَنْ أَمْرِ رَبِّهَا
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Ibn Faris says that it basically means pride.

The Quran says:

25:21	They were very rebellious	وَعَتُّوا عُنُوتًا كَبِيرًا
19:69	those who were very persistent in their rebelliousness against <i>Rahman</i>	أَشَدُّ عَلَى الرَّحْمَنِ عِتِيًّا

But in (19:8) this word has been used to mean intensity and extreme.

19:81	I have reached the extreme of old age	وَقَدْ بَلَغْتُ مِنَ الْكِبَرِ عِتِيًّا
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Raghib says that it means to reach an old age where there is no possibility of recuperation or recovery.

ع ث ر Ain-Th-R

“عَثَرَ الْعِرْقُ” (*asarat irq*): his vein throbbed.
 “عَثَرَ” (*asara*), “عَثُورًا” (*asura*): to be aware of something without intention.
 “عَثَرَ عَلَى السِّرِّ” (*asara alus sir*): he became aware of a secret.
 “أَعَثَرَهُ” (*aa’sarahu*): informed him, made him aware.
 “أَعَثَرْتُ فُلَانًا عَلَى كَذَا” (*aa’saratu fulanan ala kaza*): I informed him of something {T}.

The Quran says:

18:21	This way we informed the people about them (people came to know about them)	وَكَذَٰلِكَ أَعَثَرْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ
5:107	if you come to know that they have committed a crime	فَإِنْ عَثَرَ عَلَىٰ أَنَّهُمَا اسْتَحَقَّا إِثْمًا

“الْعَثِيرُ” (*al-isyar*): hidden effect of something. It also means earth.

“عَلَى” (*asaa*) means to create extreme chaos, to destroy to bits {T}.

Raghib says that (Ain-Th-Y) and (Ain-Y-Th) mean nearly the same thing, but usually this word of “عَلَى” (*asaa*) was used to mean mental chaos.

Al Manar says that “عَثَا” (*asaa*) means to spread chaos and trouble.

Ibn Faris says basically it means create chaos.

The Quran says:

2:60	Do not create chaos in the land. (i.e Do not spread chaos in a society)	وَلَا تَعَثُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ مُفْسِدِينَ
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“أَلْعَجَبُ” (*al-ajab*): the part of an animal’s tail joined to the body, or the last part of everything {T}.

“تَعْجَبُ” (*ta’ajjub*) is the surprise which a person feels at not knowing something, or if one sees a thing for the very first time and likes it and feels that this sort of thing has been witnessed for the first time.

“عَجَبٌ” (*a’jab*): something which is a cause for surprise or which is denied because it has never before been encountered {R}.

“عَجَبٌ” (*a’jab*): the fear and apprehension which is felt when some task is encountered which is thought to be challenging.

“عَجِيبٌ” (*a’jeeb*): the sort of thing which has not been witnessed before.

“أَلْعَجَبُ” (*al-ujb*) means pride, narcissism {T}.

Ibn Faris with reference to *Khaleel* has said that “عَجِيبٌ” (*ajeeb*) is a thing which causes wonderment and “عُجَابٌ” (*ujaab*) is a thing which has crossed the limits of “عَجِيبٌ” (*ajeeb*) i.e. extremely surprised, something witnessed beyond expectation.

The Quran says:

2:204	the matter of life that causes wonderment for you	مَنْ يُعْجِبْكَ قَوْلُهُ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا
72:1	this points to a wonderment the cause of which is not known (surprise at the revelation, as to how this Quran was presented)	إِنَّا سَمِعْنَا قُرْآنًا عَجَبًا
33:52	no matter how much their beauty attract you	وَلَوْ أَعْجَبَكَ حُسْنُهُنَّ

In reference to selecting a spouse the Quran has used this root in (2:221)

“عَجَزَ” (*ajuz*): to stay behind or to acquire something when it is almost out of hand. Usually this word means to be unable to do or get something and not being able to do something {*T, R*}.

This meaning seems appropriate where it has been used in (72:1), although these meanings are not to be found in ordinary dictionaries.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are “weakness or feebleness” as well as “the hind part of something”. Why this word is used for staying behind, speaks for itself.

“الْعَجْزَةُ” (*al-ijzah*) is said to mean an old man’s last child.

“تَعَجَّزْتُ الْبَعِيرَ” (*ta’ajjatul abeer*): I climbed the hind part of a camel {*T, R*}.

“الْعَجُوزُ” (*al-ajooz*) has about one hundred meanings in the dictionaries.

“عَجُوزٌ عَقِيمٌ” (*ajuzun aqeen*) is used in (51:29) to mean old or weak woman.

“الْعَجْزُ” (*al-ajooz*): hip, the end of anything, the last part. Plural is “الْعَجَازُ” (*aijaaz*). It also means the last part of a tree trunk which is joined to the earth.

“أَعْجَازُ نَخْلٍ” (*aijaazu nakhl*): the trunk with roots of the date palms (54:20).

“أَعْجَزَ” (*aajaz*): to weaken, to consider something to be weak or feeble.

“إِنَّهُمْ لَا يُعْجِزُونَ” (*innahum la yujizoon*): they cannot weaken (8:59).

“مُعْجِزٌ” (*mu’jiz*): one who defeats, or makes someone weaker than himself (26:32).

“مُعَاجِزِينَ” (*mu’aajizeen*): those who try to defeat each other and render helpless (22:51).

The Quran has made very clear that the Law of Requitul works in the universe including the human world. Those who go against it, may appear to be succeeding in the short term, however will always suffer the consequences in the long term. The difference is that if a system is established based on the Quranic values the good results of the system take shape very quickly i.e. within a short time scale. The natural time scale for the law of Requitul to take shape could be thousand years as it takes time for the collective deeds to bear results over a very long time e.g. the rise and fall of nations or civilisations.

The meanings for which we use the word miracle, has not appeared in the Qurani. The believe the messenger had to do something unnatural that may have mesmerized people, or made them helpless, which is not true.

“الْعَجْفُ” (*al-ajaf*): for obesity to be lost gradually.

“أَعْجَفُ” (*aajaf*) the plural is “عَجَافٌ” (*ijaaf*) which means thin or feeble {*T, M*}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:43	seven thin cows	سَبْعَ عَجَافٍ
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“عَجَفَ نَفْسَهُ عَنِ الطَّعَامِ” (*ajafa nafsuhu anit tu’aam*): he abstained from eating though he was hungry {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says basically it means weakness, as well as to abstain.

“الْعَجَلُ” (*al-ajal*), “الْعَجَلَةُ” (*al-ajalah*): speed, fastness, haste.

Raghib says it means the desire to acquire something before time.

“أَعَجَلَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*aajalatin naaqah*): the camel gave birth to still born child before time.

“لَا عَجَالَ فِي السَّيْرِ” (*salijaalu fis sair*): for a camel to be hasty in getting up, i.e. the rider has not fully accommodated himself on the back, but the camel gets up.

“الْمُعْجَالُ” (*al-mi'jaal*): date palm whose fruit ripens before expected time.

“الْعُجَيْلُ” (*al-ujail*): appetizer.

“مُسْتَعْجَلَاتُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*musta'jalaatut tareeq*): short cuts {*T, M*}.

The Quran says has used “تَعْجَلُ” (*ta'ajjalah*) and “تَأَخَّرُ” (*ta-akhhara*) in (2:2-3), and “عَاجِلَةً” (*aajilah*) against “آخِرَةً” (*aakhirah*) in (75:20-21).

These two terms of the Quran, “عَاجِلَةً” (*aajilah*) and “آخِرَةً” (*aakhirah*) are very important. For details, see heading (A-Kh-R) and (D-N-W). For example, say that there are two farmers. Each of them has a quantity of wheat which they have kept as seeds. There is dearth of food with them. One of the farmers gets the wheat grinded that he had kept for seeding. His shortage of food ends, but the second farmer bears the temporary shortage and sows the seed for the next crop. For some time he faces great difficulty due to shortage of food but then there is abundance of food as the crop matures and he reaps the benefit.

The first farmer acted hastily, i.e. he had his eye on the immediate benefit which was acquired quickly. But the second farmer had his eye on the end benefit, that is, he delayed the self-gratification. This is the difference between “عَاجِلَةً” (*aajilah*) and “آخِرَةً” (*aakhirah*). The Quran says that we give quick benefits to those who seek immediate benefits, but they have no part in the happiness of the future (2:200, 17:18). Conversely, those who keep their eye on the happiness of the future also find their future to be blissful, and after the initial turmoil, the present too is beneficial (2:201, 17:19). These are the two groups who are compared in the Quran.

For example:

76:28	One strives for immediate benefits and the other group strives for the happiness of the future	تُحِبُّونَ الْعَاجِلَةَ وَتَذَرُونَ الْآخِرَةَ
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Also see (75:20-21)

The word “future” covers both the coming generations and the life hereafter. The Quran gives us a program which covers both aspects in detail. The life of “عَاجِلَةً” (*aajilah*) and “آخِرَةً” (*aakhirah*) provides happiness of in both parts of the life. For example one group thinks that man's present life is all there is (i.e. physical life) and therefore the benefits are immediate. The other group thinks that man's life consists not only of his physical life but also the life in the hereafter. His physical life ends here but his self goes on and the benefits for this self are accrued in the “آخِرَةً” (*aakhirah*) against the “عَاجِلَةً” (*aajilaah*). These are permanent values. The Quran gives a program which not only benefits his physical life but also helps nurture his self. Thus he gets the benefits of both this world and the hereafter.

“الْعَجَلُ” (*al-ajal*) in the *Humair* dictionary means earth. That is why “خُلِقَ الْإِنْسَانُ مِنْ عَجَلٍ” (*khuliqaal insaana min ajal*) in (21:37) has been taken to mean that man has been created from earth {*M*}. This is supported by other places in the Quran where man's creation is said to have been initiated from earth (32:7).

Surah *Bani-Israel* says:

17:11	man is hasty	وَكَانَ الْإِنْسَانُ عَجُولًا
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Therefore if this meaning is taken in (21:37) as well, then it seems more appropriate. It is stated:

21:37	..then you will not ask it to be hastened (i.e. punishment as a reward of their deeds)	فَلَا تَسْتَعْجِلُونِ
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It is only the guidance provided by the revelation which enables man to keep an eye on the long term future. Working for immediate benefits makes a man impatient and raises the objection in response to invitation to the guidance that why the results of bad deeds do not show up quickly? According to the Law of Requitul the results of our deeds do not show up quickly and there is a gap between what we do and their effects to show up later. For example there is a time lag between the time we sow seeds and for the crop to mature. Those who live according to the guidance provided by the revelation are not bothered by the fact that the result of their deeds are not immediate. They develop a conviction that on the Law of Requitul works with evidence around them and they live their life with this in mind.

“الْعَجَلُ” (*al-ijl*): a calf. Some think that a month old calf is called “عَجَلٌ” (*ijl*) as in (2:92) and (20:88) {T}. Some also think that up to one year old calf is called “عَجَلٌ” (*ijl*).

Raghib says there is a connotation of haste in this word, i.e. a calf is very active and fast but when the calf turns into an ox it is no longer called so.

In surah *Al-Qiyamah* the Messenger (*pbuh*) has been guided:

75:16	Do not move your tongue along with it so that you can grasp it quickly	لَا تُخْرُجْ بِهِ لِسَانَكَ لِتَعْجَلَ بِهِ
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But as it has been said under heading (H-R-K), its meaning becomes clear when taken in consonance with (20:114) where it is said:

20:114	do not make haste about doing something until you are given the whole program about it i.e. revealed further details	وَلَا تَعْجَلْ بِالْقُرْآنِ مِنْ قَبْلِ أَنْ يُقْضَىٰ إِلَيْكَ وَحْيُهُ
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When the revelation expostulate the whole program, then act accordingly. It is also noted under the heading (H-R-K) that it may also mean the human record of deeds. In this case there will be no connection between (20:114) and (75:16), but the meaning of (20:114) is evident even without it.

Ain-J-M ع ج م

In the Arabic dictionary, the meaning of (Ain-J-M) is of being unclear and ambiguous i.e. something which remains unexplained.

“الْأَعْجَمُ” (*al-a'jam*): a person whose meaning is not clear despite him being an Arab. The plurals are “أَعْجَمٌ” (*a'aajim*), “أَعْجَمُونَ” (*aaajamoon*) and “أَعْجَمِينَ” (*aaajameen*). Thereafter “الْعَجَمِيُّ” (*al-ajami*) came to be used as a description for every person who was not an Arab, no matter even if he was very eloquent. “الْأَعْجَمُ” (*al-aaajam*): a dumb person.

Lataif-ul-Lugha says that “الْعَجَمِيُّ” (*al-jamiyyu*) means being a non-Arab, even if he is eloquent, and “الْأَعْجَمِيُّ” (*al-aa'jami*) means non-eloquent even if this person is an Arab.

“أَعْجَمَ فُلَانٌ الْكَلَامَ” (*aa'jam fulanun kalam*): he kept the matter ambiguous.

“بَابٌ مُعْجَمٌ” (*babun mo'jam*): closed door.

“إِسْتَعْجَمَتِ الدَّارُ” (*ista'jamatid daar*): house became empty and there was no one to answer {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris says it means silence and quiet.

In the Quran, “الْعَجَمِيُّ” (*aa'jami-un*) has appeared against “عَرَبِيٌّ مُبِينٌ” (*arabiyyan mubeen*), as in (26:198) and (41:44).

“الْعَرَبِيُّ” (*al-arabiyyu*) means eloquent. See heading (Ain-R-B).

“إِعْدَادٌ” (*e'daad*): to prepare, to provide.

“أَعْدَدْتُ لِحَوَائِثِ الدَّهْرِ مِنَ الْمَالِ وَالسَّلَاحِ” (*aadudtu: lihawadisid dahar minal maali was silaah*): I have prepared for the vicissitudes of life.

“إِسْتَعَدَّ” (*ista'addalahu*): prepared and became ready for it.

“عَدَّ” (*adda*), “يَعُدُّ” (*ya-uddu*), “عَدًّا” (*adda*): to count.

“عَدَدٌ” (*adad*) and “عَدِيدٌ” (*adeed*) are nouns that are derived from it {*T, M*}.

14:34	And you count all blessings of Allah , you would not succeed.	وَ إِنْ تَعُدُّوا نِعْمَتَ اللَّهِ لَا تَحْصُوهَا
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“مَعْدُودٌ” (*ma'dood*): counted {*T, M*}.

“أَيَّاماً مَّعْدُودَةً” (*ayyaman ma'doodah*): numbered days, or the days which are counted (2:80) {*T, M*}.

When *Yusuf* was sold by the caravan members in the market of Egypt, it is said:

12:20	They sold him for a small amount of coins	دَرَاهِمَ مَّعْدُودَةٍ
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“أَيَّاماً مَّعْدُودَاتٍ” (*ayyaman ma'doodaat*) has also been used for the days of fasting (2:184). But it has been explained a little later where it is said:

2:185	Those among you who are at home during this month, should fast	فَمَنْ شَهِدَ مِنْكُمُ الشَّهْرَ فَلْيَصُمْهُ
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It is evident from this that fasting is for the entire month of Ramadan.

“عِدَّةٌ” (*iddah*): refers to the period a divorced woman has to wait before remarrying {*T, M*}.

“الْعِدَّةُ” (*al-uddah*) is wealth kept for rainy days {*T, M*}.

“عَدًّا” (*addan*): to count (19:84).

“عَدَدًا” (*adada*): several, counted (18:11).

“عِدَّةٌ” (*iddah*): number, count (9:36).

“عُدَّةٌ” (*uddah*): goods which are ready, which are kept safe to meet any eventuality (9:46).

“أَعَدَّ” (*a'adda*): to prepare, to provide (9:100).

“إِعْدَدَّ” (*itadda*): to count (33:49).

“الْعَدَسُ” (*al-adas*): a kind of lentil {*T, M*}. The Quran uses it in (2:61).

“الْعَدْلُ” (*al-idl*): the goods or weight laden on both sides of a camel, which is equal in weight.
 “عَدْلٌ” (*idl*): each equal part on a weight scale. It basically means to be equal.
 “عَدْلُ الْمِيزَانِ” (*addalal meezaan*): balanced the scales.
 “فَاعْتَدَلْ” (*fa’tadal*): thus the scales were balanced.
 “عَادَ لَهُ” (*aadalahu*), “مُعَادَلَةً” (*mu’aadalah*): became equal in weight.
 “عَادَلَ بَيْنَ الشَّيْئَيْنِ” (*adala bainash shaiyeen*): made two things equal in weight, made even.
 “عَدَلَهُ فِي الْمَحْمِلِ وَعَادَلَهُ” (*addalahu fi lmahmili wa aadalahu*): ride an animal with someone of equal weight.
 “الْعَدْلُ” (*al-udlu*), “الْعَدْلُ” (*al-idlu*), “الْعَدِيلُ” (*al-adeel*): alike, similar, of equal weight.
 “إِعْتَدَالَ” (*e’tidaal*): to be between two conditions according to a state.
 “فَعَدَلَك” (*fa’adalaka*): God has made man in proportion (82:7). He has kept full balance and proportion while creating him. He has made him stand upright. For him it is necessary to keep balance.
 “عَدْلٌ” (*adal*): the right compensation.
 “أَوْ عَدْلٌ ذَالِكُ صَيَامًا” (*au-adlu zaalika siyaama*): to have equal weight (5:95).

Ibn Faris says “عَدْلٌ” (*adal*) also means compensation.

2:48	no compensation will be accepted from him	لَا يُؤْخَذُ مِنْهَا عَدْلٌ
6:70	even if he is ready to pay any kind of compensation	وَأَنْ تَعْدِلَ كُلُّ عَدْلٍ
49:9	By justice and equality.	بِالْعَدْلِ وَأَقْسِطُوا

The meaning of “قِسْطٌ” (*qist*) will be related in the heading (Q-S-T).

The Quran has ordered to do “عَدْلٌ” (*adal*) and “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ihsaan*) in (16:90). It means that to give full compensation to someone is doing “عَدْلٌ” (*adal*), and to complete his shortcomings and set his balance right is “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ihsaan*). See heading (H-S-N).

To mean similar and example, this word has been used in surah *Al-Anaam*:

6:151	these people equate others to Allah	وَهُمْ يَرْجِعُ يَعْدِلُونَ
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“عَدَلَ عَنِ الطَّرِيقِ” (*adala anit tareeq*): to move away from a path.

“عَدَلَ الطَّرِيقِ” (*adalat tareeq*): a road bent towards one side {T}.

“عَادَلَ الشَّيْءُ” (*aadalash shaiyi*): a thing that became crooked {M}.

Surah *An-Namal* says:

27:60	These are the people who have moved away from the right path	بَلْ هُمْ قَوْمٌ يَعْدِلُونَ
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Ibn Faris says that it has two meanings which are opposite to each other. It means to be smooth as well as to be crooked or bent. But it is generally thought that the meaning to be crooked is derived from the use of “عُنٌ” (*un*).

A Quranic society is based on “عَدْلٌ” (*adal*) and “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ihsaan*), that is, justice and balance. In this society every individual gets full return for his labor, and no excess is committed against anyone. Individuals in such a society decide to take only that which is enough to meet their needs and leave the rest (of the resources) for the sustenance of mankind at large (2:219). The rest will be for such people who due to some reason cannot earn their livelihood, or whose return for labor cannot be enough to meet their needs. To complete their shortcoming is called “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ihsaan*). This “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ihsaan*) is no favor to anyone, neither is it some sort of charity, but the act of creating a balance. The individuals of such society decide that the returns for their labor will be available to all. All this (the resources) is under the administrator of this system and is used for the sustenance of every individual of society who needs it. This is why the Quran along with ordering “عَدْلٌ” (*adal*) and “إِحْسَانٌ” (*ihsaan*) has ordered to abstain from “فَحْشَاءٌ” (*fahsha*) and “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) (16:90). “فَحْشَاءٌ” (*fahsha*) means miserliness, and “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*)

means the excuses that human intelligence cooks up, which instigate a man to accumulate for himself whatever he can by whatever means.

Ain-D-N ع د ن

“عَدَنَ” (*adan*), “يَعْدُنُ” (*ya’dun*), “يَعْدِي” (*ya’din*): to stay somewhere.
 “جَنَاتُ عَدْنٍ” (*jannatu a’dn*): gardens in which one can stay with permanence, a mine, and a place where a thing is born and where it is always found. It means the center of anything.
 “الْمَعَادِنُ” (*al-ma’adin*): roots {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says “جَنَاتُ عَدْنٍ” (*jannaati adan*) in 9:72. It means the residences of comfort and luxury.

Ibn Faris says it means gardens to stay in, in other words, such gardens in which one can also live.

Ain-D-W ع د و

“الْعَدَاءُ” (*al-adaa’u*) and “الْعَدَاةُ” (*al-udawa’u*) means distance.
 “الْعَدَى” (*al-ida*): strangers who are apart from one another.
 “الْعُدْوَةُ” (*al-udwah*): a distant place.
 “الْعِدْوَةُ” (*al-idwah*), “الْعُدْوَةُ” (*al-udwah*), “الْعَدْوَةُ” (*al-adwah*): corner, bend or bank.
 “الْعِدَى” (*al-ida*): a sort of wooden wedge, a stick placed between two pieces of wood to separate them.
 “تَعَادَى” (*ta’aada*): distant from each other {*T*}, thus this root has a basic connotation of distance.
 “عَدُوٌّ” (*aduwwun*) means enemy due to this distance, i.e. the opposite of friend. It is also the opposite of “وَلِيٌّ” (*waliyyu*) which someone who does not help.
 “تَعَادَى الْقَوْمُ” (*ta’aadal qoum*): these nations had enmity with each other {*T*}.
 “الْعَدَى” (*al-ida*): the enemy with whom you are at war.
 “الْعَادِيَاتُ” (*al-aadiyaat*): the horses of fighters, that is, the horses who run afar.
 “عَدَا” (*a’da*), “يَعْدُو” (*ya’doo*), “عَدَا” (*adwa*), “عَدَوْنَا” (*adawana*), “تَعَدَاءُ” (*ta’da*): to walk fast or run.
 “تَعَادَوْا” (*ta’aadau*): they competed in speed {*T*}.

Raghib says “عَدُوٌّ” (*adwun*) means to cross a limit and to be unable to reach mutual agreement or harmony. If it is in disharmony with respect to speed, then it is called “عَدُوٌّ” (*adwun*). If it is with respect to mutual feelings, then it will be called “عَدَاوَةٌ” (*adawah*). If it is with respect to deterioration in *adal* and justice, then it will be called “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) {*T*}.

“عَدَا عَلَيْهِ” (*ada alaihi*): he committed excesses on him {*T*}, in other words, crossed the limit.
 “تَعَدَاهُ” (*ta’addahu*): he exceeded it, went across.
 “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) also means to commit the worst of excesses {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to exceed a limit in general, or in something in which the laid down limit should have been respected.

“أَعَدَى الْأَمْرَ” (*aad-al-amr*): he proceeded from one thing to another.
 “أَعْدَاهُ” (*aa’da*), “أَلْدَاهُ” (*ud-daa’u*): a disease that was passed on to him, or a disease that became infectious {*T*}.
 “النَّعَادِي” (*at-ta’aadi*): uneven places {*T*}.
 “الْعُدْوَى” (*al-adwaa*) means for a disease to be communicable. It also means to ask a king to help deliver from some oppression {*M*}.

The Quran relates in the tale about *Adam* that when the humans instead of living as one united community started a life of parties and divisions, then their individual interests took priority and as a consequence enmity and distances were created among them (2:36). Conversely life should be such in which the hearts should be inter-twined just as a cloud integrates into another (3:102).

Mutual “عَدَاوَةٌ” (*adawah*) creates “الْتَعَادَى” (*at-ta’aadi*), or unevenness. That is why this root has appeared against “مَوَدَّةٌ” (*mawaddah*) in (60:7).

In surah *Al-Baqrah* “إِعْتَدَاءٌ” (*i’tida*) and “عِصْيَانٌ” (*isyaan*) have come to mean similar things (2:61), that is, one who forgets the limits and crosses them, gets rebellious. Similarly the word “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) has come opposite to “تَقْوَى” (*taqwa*) in (5:2). “تَقْوَى” (*taqwa*) means to observe the limits defined by Allah in the Quran. Thus “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) would mean forgetting the limits or crossing them. In (2:193) the word “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) has come to mean the excess which can be termed punishment. That is, “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) of oppressors engulfs themselves.

In surah *Al-Ma’idah*, “عَدَاوَةٌ” (*adawah*) and “بَغْضَاءٌ” (*baghda’u*) has come together (5:64).

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:28	do not ignore them	وَلَا تَعُدُّ عَيْنَاكَ عَنْهُمْ
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“عُدْوَةٌ” (*udwah*): edge (8:42).

The Quran has used terms as “إِثْمٌ” (*ism*) and “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) to mean crime. “إِثْمٌ” (*ism*) means that which slows down a man who cannot keep pace with others. See heading (A-S-M). “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) means to be rebellious and move ahead. The system of Islam wants all individuals to be mutually helpful and thus proceed together. See heading (S-L-M). He who stays behind is also a criminal. It also means to be rebellious and move ahead of a caravan. That is, a criminal. If “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) is taken together with “تَعْدِيَةٌ” (*ta’diyah*), then it would mean such crimes which are infectious or that which affect other individuals of society as well.

Details can be found under the headings (A-D-M) and (Sh-J-R).

And “إِثْمٌ” (*ism*) would mean a crime which only affects the criminal. For details see (A-Th-M).

“عَادٌ” (*aad*): one who breaks the laws or crosses limits (2:173).

“تَعَدَّى” (*ta’adda*): to exceed or cross a limit (2:229).

“إِعْتَدَى” (*i’tada*): to commit excesses (2:178).

“مُعْتَدٍ” (*mo’tid*): one who commits excesses (2:190).

The plural is “مُعْتَدُونَ” (*mo’tadoon*) and “مُعْتَدِينَ” (*mo’tadeen*).

ع ذ ب Ain-Dh-B

There are three elements in the basic meaning of this root.

- 1) The sweetness or delightfulness of water that quenches thirst.
- 2) Difficulties and pain which are an obstacle to a comfortable life.
- 3) Hurdle, to prevent.

To comprehend these meanings one has to conceive of the dwellers of the Arab desert. Water was very short there and sweet water is even harder to get. This commodity was no less than a benevolence which was acquired after great search, hardship and quarrels. Several days had to be spent without it, i.e. one had to live without availability of fresh water for several days.

“الْعَذْبُ” (*al’azb*): delightful, sweet water.

The Quran says:

25:53	one of them is delightful (water)	هَذَا عَذْبٌ فُرَاتٍ
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“إِسْتَعَذَّبَ الرَّجُلُ مَاءَهُ” (*asta’zabar rajulu maa’ahu*): that man brought sweet water (potable water).

“أَعَذَّبَ الْخَوْضَ” (*aa’zabal hauz*): to clean a pond of straws etc. from the surface of water.

“الْأَعْذَابَانِ” (*al-a’zabaan*): two delightful things, either wine or saliva of one’s mouth {*T, M*}.

“عَذَابٌ” (*a'zab*): straws etc. which rise to the surface of water and thus pollute the drinking water. It also means the pieces of rags which professional women mourners keep with them.

“عَذْبَةٌ” (*azbah*): a tree toxic to camels. Hence it means punishment, hunger, thirst and pain {*T, M*}.

“عَذُوبٌ” (*a'zoob*), “عَازِبٌ” (*aazib*): man, camel or horse who stops eating or drinking due to intensity of thirst.

“عَازِبٌ” (*aazib*): he who can spend the night without eating anything. This word is also used for someone who does not enjoy any protection or shade. As such, “عَازِبٌ” (*azaab*) is used for any sort of deprivation i.e. hunger or thirst or any plight or difficulty. It also means to prevent one from reaching something or somewhere.

“عَذَبَهُ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ” (*azaabahu anish shamsii*) and “أَسْتَعَذَّبَهُ” (*azabahu*) and “أَعَذَّابَهُ” (*asta'zabahu*) means preventing one from something {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris has said that the matter of this word cannot be superimposed on other words and neither can these words be clubbed to mean the same thing.

The Quran has used “عَذَابٌ” (*azaab*) to mean all the inequities that the Pharaoh's nation incurred on its slaves of *Israelis* (20:27). Quran uses “مُفْلِحُونَ” (*muflihoon*) against “لَهُمْ عَذَابٌ عَظِيمٌ” (*lahum azaaboon azeem*) in Surah *Al-Baqrah* in (2:7), which makes it clear that “عَذَابٌ” (*azaab*) means all the inequities of life and any deprivation. Hence it means any deprivation so severe that it disables one to benefit from the pleasant things in this life.

This word has also been used to mean the punishment that is meted out by the courts (4:25), (24:2). Here the aspect of stopping someone or preventing from something is more prominent than suffering, because the very aim of legal punishment is to stop someone or preventing from committing crimes.

“عَذَابٌ” (*azaab*) from Allah means the destructive result of man's own wrong doings and because of this Allah has also been called “مُعَذِّبٌ” (*mu-azzib*) in (7:164) i.e. ensuring the recompense of what we do. Anyone who tastes such “مُعَذِّبٌ” (*azaab*) is called “مُعَذَّبٌ” (*mu-azzab*) as in (26:213). According to the Quran, a life of deprivation and misery during one's lifetime (20:134) i.e. hunger and fear are a form of “عَذَابٌ” (*azaab*) as in (16:114). The stoppage of heavenly blessing is also “عَذَابٌ” (*azaab*) as in (7:96). Divisions and party differences are forms of “عَذَابٌ” (*azaab*) as in (6:65). Mutual differences are called “عَذَابٌ” (*azaab*) in (3:104). The removal and elimination of differences is a blessing (11:116-118). The above are only a few forms of Allah's “عَذَابٌ” (*azaab*). Its details are noted and covered throughout the Quran.

Ain-Dh-R ع ذ ر

“الْعُذْرُ” (*al-azr*) means the efforts of a man in trying to mitigate his faults {*R*}. It also means the excuse or reason that man presents for some fault, crime or mistake {*M*}.

Ibn Faris says it is only man's way of extenuating his fault or crime, simply through words and not by any action of repentance.

Real meaning of “عِزْرَةٌ” (*azirah*) is the open space in front of houses, but later this word came to be used for the garbage that is thrown in such open grounds {*R*}.

“عَذْرَ الشَّيْءِ” (*azzarash shaiyee*): a thing with which something is adulterated. Later it began to be used for removing faults from man's actions.

“أَعَذَّرَ الْغُلَامَ إِعْذَارًا” (*aa-zaral ghulama izara*): he circumcised his son. Hymen is also called “عُزْرَةٌ” (*uzrah*).

“أَعَذَّرَ الرَّجُلُ إِعْذَارًا” (*aa-zarar rujulko eh-zara*) is said when sins of a man become very copious.

“أَعَذَّرَتِ الدَّارُ” (*aa-zaratid daar*): house has become very dirty.

“أَعْتَذَرَتِ الْمَنَازِلُ” (*eh-tazaratil manzil*): signs of houses disappeared i.e. destroyed. {*T*}.

Ibn Faris concludes that there is no room for conjecture here, but every word holds its own meaning.

Surah *Al-Mursalat* says:

77:6	Whether of justification or of warning	عَذْرًا أَوْ تَذَرًا
30:57	No excuses of theirs will avail	مَعَاذِرُهُمْ

In (30:57), “مَعَذِرَةٌ” (*ma-zerah*) can also mean “عَذْرٌ” (*azr*) and its meaning includes excuse or argument {T}.

In the Yemen’s dictionary the word “مَعَاذِيرُ” (*ma-aazeeru*) means wail as well as need. As such, “الْقَى مَعَاذِيرَهُ” (*alqa ma-zeerahu*) would mean hiding or throwing a wail on truth to cover it. It may also mean to present an argument.

Surah *Al-Qiyamah* uses “مَعَاذِيرُهُ” (*ma-aazeerahu*) in (75:15), the singular of which is “مِعْدَارٌ” (*mezaar*). Surah *At-Taubah* says “لَا تَعْتَذِرُوا” (*la tazeru*) in (9:69), which means “to make lame excuses”.

“عَذْرٌ” (*azzara*): present such an excuse which cannot be proven {T}.

Surah *At-Taubah* says “مُعَذِّرُونَ” (*mu-azzeroon*) in (9:60) which means this very thing, or the presenter of lame excuses, or those who are at fault.

Ibn Faris says this means those people who had no excuse but still made false excuses.

“تَعَذَّرَ الْأَمْرُ عَلَيْهِ” (*ta-azzaral amru alaih*): Task became difficult for him.

As such, whenever “عَذْرٌ” (*azr*) or excuse will be heartfelt, it would mean that the person making the mistake genuinely repents it, and he is genuinely explaining why the mistake was made. This sort of “عَذْرٌ” (*uzr*) is appreciated. The other and more usual type of “عَذْرٌ” (*azr*) is when a person gives wrong reason or logic for his mistake and wants to mitigate his mistake simply through verbal excuses.

Ain-R-B ع ر ب

“الْعَرَبُ” (*al-arab*) or “الْعَرَبُ” (*al-arb*) means the people of Arabia.

Raghib writes that the progeny of the messenger *Ismail* is called “الْعَرَبُ” (*al-arab*).

Taj-ul-Uroos says the descendants of *Ya’ru-bubnu qaihtaan* are called “عرب” (*arab*) or “عاربة” (*arba*). This man was the forefather of the Arabic people and was first person to speak in Arabic language {T}. But this explanation does not seem appealing.

“الْأَعْرَابُ” (*al-airaab*) is the plural of “أَعْرَابِيٌّ” (*a-rabbi’u*). This word is used for the Arabic tribes which dwell in the deserts and forests {M}. The Quran has used this word for these desert dwellers in (9:97).

“الْعَرَبِيُّ” (*al-arabiyyu*): one who makes clear, i.e. eloquent {M}.

“الْأَعْرَابُ” (*al-airaab*): to clarify something.

“عَرَبْتُ لَهُ الْكَلَامَ” (*arrabtu lahu kalaam*): I told him about it clearly {T}.

As such, when the Quran says “حُكْمًا عَرَبِيًّا” (*hukman arabiyya*) as in (13:37), or “قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا” (*quranan arabiyya*) in (12:1), or “لِسَانًا عَرَبِيًّا” (*lisanan arabiyya*) in (46:12), it does not mean that Quran is in Arabic language, but it means a clear book, i.e. a book which explains everything very clearly. Therefore Surah *Az-Zumr* explains “قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا” (*quranan arabiyya*) by adding “غَيْرَ ذِي عِوَجٍ” (*ghaira zee iwaj*) to it in (39:28). In other words, it means such a clear book which has no complications and is simple to understand (54:17).

“الْعَرُوبُ” (*al-arub*): a wife who is loved by her husband, and who is madly in love with her husband as well, and expresses that love, and laughs and enjoys life with him {*Ibn Qateeba* vol.2}.

Ibn Faris says that this root basically means to open something up and make it clear. He says that “عُرُوبٌ” (*arub*) would mean purity of soul and body. He also says that it may mean some deformity in body or limb.

By happiness and pure soul one would mean a joyful and happy woman.

“عَرِبَتْ مَعِدَتَهُ” (*aribat ma-e datahu*) would mean that his stomach had problem.

“إِمْرَأَةٌ عُرُوبٌ” (*imra-atun urub*) also means a woman of bad habits or character. The plural of “عُرُوبٌ” (*arub*) is “عُرَبٌ” (*urub*).

About the wives in a heavenly society, it is said “عُرُبًا أَتْرَابًا” (*uruban atraba*) in (56:37). But from the context it is found that, aside from love that is the basic quality of a good marital relationship, it also means a very civilized and straight forward woman because the Quran has called the women of the era before the advent of the Quran as “غَيْرُ مُبِينٍ” (*ghairu mubeen*) in (43:18). This means a woman who cannot explain her intent clearly due to the environmental effects. However, when such women were trained in a Quranic society, then they became very eloquent, confident, and straight forward.

“الَّتَعْرِبُ” (*al-ta'reeb*): not only to talk clearly but also to talk with reason {T}. Therefore in a Quranic society both men and women talk honestly, clearly and intellectually with reason.

Ain-R-J

ع ر ج

“عَرَجَ” (*araj*): to climb higher.

“عَرَجَ فِي الدَّرَجَةِ” (*araja fid daraja*): to climb stairs.

“مَعْرَاجٌ” (*ma'raj*): stairs.

“مَعْرَاجٌ” (*meraj*) with plural form “مَعَارِجُ” (*ma'arij*) also means a ladder. This word has not been used by the Quran.

“عَرَجَ” (*araja*), “يَعْرُجُ” (*ya'ruj*): something happened to his leg and he started limping because of it. This limping is only temporary. For permanent limping the term “عَرَجَ يَعْجُجُ” (*arija ya'ruj*) will be used.

“أَعْرَجُ” (*aaraju*): a lame man, i.e. a man who walks on level ground as if he is climbing the stairs.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this matter is

- 1) Temporary or permanent bending to one side or limpness.
- 2) Height and evolution.

“أَلْعَرَجُ” (*al-araj*): a lame man, because a lame man walks crookedly.

About the evolution of things in the universe the Quran says:

32:5	Allah decides about a scheme according to His own laws or Will, then starts creating as per His scheme from its lowest form	يُذَبِّرُ الْأَمْرَمِنَ السَّمَاءِ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ
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Then that thing rises or evolves to new heights from its basic creation, and every stage in that evolution towards its completion may take a thousand years or even fifty thousand years (70:4). This is why Allah has called Himself “ذِي الْمَعَارِجِ” (*zil ma-arij*) in (70:3), i.e. Creator and Overseer of the evolutionary process.

This means that Allah makes every creation evolves to reach its own completion. In this way He declared Himself to be on the right path (11:56) i.e. on a balanced path and direction - “ذِي الْمَعَارِجِ” (*zil ma'aarij*) means to be on the Right Path, and also means that Allah is taking the Universe forward. The universe is dynamic and moving forward and its movement is linear not cyclic like the Greeks thought. At the same time this universe is also evolving towards its intended purpose. The Quran has stated that the purpose of the universe is to ensure that each one of us is accountable for our deeds and none is dealt unjustly (45:22). This is the concept of the universe that is presented by the Quran. As the universe dynamic, man must not remain static and should constantly strive progressively forward and keep ascending.

Surah *An-Noor* has used “أَعْرَجُ” (*aaraj*) to mean a lame man in (24:11). Since there is a bend in the leg of a lame man, therefore the bended branch of a date palm is also called “عُرْجُونُ” (*urjoon*) as in (36:39) {*T, R*}.

Ibn Faris says “إِنْعَرَجَ الطَّرِيقُ” (*inn arajaz zareeq*) means that there was a bend in the road, or that the road had a bend in it.

“الْعُرْجُ” (*al-arj*): 80 to 90 camels according to *Ibn Faris*.

Ain-R-J-N

ع ر ج ن

“عُرْجُونُ” (*urjoon*): the crooked branch of a date palm (36:39). See heading (Ain-R-J).

Ain-R-R

ع ر ر

“الْعُرُّ” (*al-arru*), “الْعُرَّةُ” (*al-urru*), “الْعُرَّةُ” (*al-arrah*): disease of scratching.

“الْمَعْرَةُ” (*al-ma'arah*): any sort of difficulty, pain or loss. This word also means mistake, error, or sin.

“عَرَّةٌ” (*arrah*): he was the cause of pain {*T, R*}.

Surah *A-Fatah* says:

48:25	lest you may come to harm because of them	فَتَصِيبُكُمْ مِنْهُمْ مَعَرَّةٌ
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“عَرَّةٌ” (*arrah*), “إِعْتَرَّةٌ” (*itarrah*): to go to someone and ask for a favor without begging, or appear before someone to ask pardon.

Ibnul Qitah says “الْمُعْتَرُّ” (*al-mu'atarru*) means one who meets. But a group of linguists says that “الْقَانِعُ” (*an-naafeh*) means the beneficiary and “مُعْتَرٌّ” (*mu-attiru*) is a person who hovers around you for some favor whether he says so or not.

The Quran says:

22:36	he is in misery	الْقَائِمُ وَالْمُعْتَرِّ
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Ibn Faris says this word is used for a deprived man who hovers around you all the time to carry favor. The basic meaning of this matter is to attach something bad to some other thing.

Ain-R-Sh

ع ر ش

“الْعَرْشُ” (*al-arsh*): a member of something, or a pillar supporting a roof, or the roof itself, or any other support on which a roof rests {*T, R*}.

Raghib has said that “الْعَرْشُ” (*al-arsh*) is used for anything with a roof above it. The plural is “عُرُوشٌ” (*uroosh*). It is also used to mean a king's throne. Thus this word came to mean government or authority and kingdom.

The author of *Lataif-ul-lugha* has said it means overpowering and strength.

Ibn Faris says it means the height or ascent in anything that is made or created.

The Quran says:

27:23	She (Queen <i>Saba</i>) had a very big throne	وَلَهَا عَرْشٌ عَظِيمٌ
2:259	The houses in this settlement had fallen on their own roofs or pillars	وَهِيَ خَاوِيَةٌ عَلَى عُرُوشِهَا

“جَنَّاتٍ مَّعْرُوشَاتٍ” (*jannatin marooshaat*): a garden where vines are laid out on lattice work, such as grape vines (6:142).

The Quran has used the word “عَرْشٌ” (*arsh*) to mean Allah quite a few times, for instance:

27:29	He is the creator of the entire universe and also holds the authority and control over it	هُوَ رَبُّ الْعَرْشِ الْعَظِيمِ
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It also means the highest authority and central control. This control is very firm and no weakness can enter this control.

7:54	Then he ascended on his throne	ثُمَّ اسْتَوَىٰ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ
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“اسْتَوَىٰ” (*istawa*): to sit firmly on something or somewhere, or to be able to overpower fully.

The Quran says:

11:7	His central throne is on water	وَكَانَ عَرْشُهُ عَلَى الْمَاءِ
21:30	We have given life to everything from water	وَجَعَلْنَا مِنَ الْمَاءِ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ حَيٍّ

This point needs further explanation.

This means that the essence of the physical life is water - this is corroborated by modern day research which says that there can be no life without water. Therefore when the Quran says that Allah's throne is on water, then it means that He has control over every living thing through His laws. Allah's control is also working in the outer universe according to His laws. He has made laws for everything and none can go against these laws. In the human affairs the revelation is provided as a source of external guidance as an option. It is up to us to accept it or reject and then live by the consequences of our choice. This is called the law of requital i.e. every cause has an effect. This is briefly the explanation that Allah's throne is spread out over the entire universe.

ع ر ض Ain-R-Zd

“عَرَضٌ” (*arz*): to become apparent or come into full sight, or to present before someone (40:46).

“عَرَضَ لَهُ كَذَاً” (*araza lahu kaza*): it so happened with him; he saw something cursorily.

“عَرَضَ عَلَيْهِ كَذَاً” (*araza alaihi kaza*): showed him a particular thing.

“عَرَضَ الشَّيْءُ” (*arazash shaiyee*): the thing became apparent.

“الْعَارِضُ” (*al-aariz*): the event that befalls you or thing that comes before you.

“الْعَارِضَةُ” (*al-ariza*): the upper wood of a door frame.

“الْعَارِضُ” (*al-aariz*): the cloud that is spread on the horizon (46:24).

“الْعَرْضُ” (*al-arz*): width of something {T}.

The Quran says about heavenly society:

57:21	the width of which is the same as the entire universe	عَرْضُهَا كَعَرْضِ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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“أَعْرَضَ عَنْهُ” (*aaraza unhu*): avoided him, turned away from him.

“عَرَضَ الْفَرَسُ فِي عَدْوِهِ” (*araza alfarasu fe adweh*): the horse ran by leaning his neck and head to one side.

That is, instead of keeping himself straight, the horse ran breadth wise.

“إِعْتِرَاضٌ” (*itiraaz*): for something to come in front to obstruct the way {T}.

“عُرْضَةٌ” (*urzatah*): cover (2:224)

“الْعَرَضُ” (*al-arazu*): household goods, wealth and riches (22:33).

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:169	these people obtain short sighted benefits or goods and do not worry about the future	يَأْخُذُونَ عَرَضَ هَذَا الْأَدْنَىٰ
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Here the word “عَرَضٌ” (*araza*) means worldly goods {R}.

Raghib has said that “الْعَرْضُ” (*al-arzu*) also means non-lasting or temporary thing.

Surah *At-Tauba* says:

9:42	if there is some benefit that can accrue quickly	لَوْ كَانَ عَرَضًا قَرِيْبًا
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Here too the meaning of “عَرْضُ” (*araza*) is clear.

The Quran has explained “مُعْرِضُونَ” (*murizoon*) by saying “تَوَلَّيْتُمْ” (*tawallaitum*) (2:83, 3:22). Therefore it means those who turn away or avoid, or those who find ways for avoiding the Quran, or those who move to aside.

“أَعْرِضْ عَنِ الْمُشْرِكِيْنَ” (*aariz anil mushrikeen*) in (15:94) has the same meaning as “فَاصْفَحْ” (*fasfah*) in (15:85). That is, to leave them alone or move to aside.

Ain-R-F ع ر ف

“الْعَرْفُ” (*al-arf*): smell, scent.

“عَرَفْتُهُ” (*arafutu*): I found His scent. From here it means to recognize something.

Raghib says that “مَعْرِفَةٌ” (*marifatah*) or “عِرْفَانٌ” (*irfaan*) is to understand something from the signs by using the human intellect and reasoning.

It is obvious that this will not be equal to knowledge and that is why it is said (*Allahu ya'lum*) which means that only Allah knows for certain. “اَللّٰهُ يَعْْرِفُ” (*Allahu yurifu*) is not said because Allah knows with certainty about everything. It means that a man cannot know anything about Allah, except what He has said about Himself in the Quran. But by deliberating on the things in the universe, which are His creations, we can come to understand His Attributes. This is called “مَعْرِفَتٌ” (*ma'arfat*) or understanding Allah {*T*}. The Quran has not used the word “مَعْرِفَتٌ” (*ma'arfat*) or understanding of Allah, but has always used the word ‘knowledge’.

By deliberating on the universe and the truths in the Quran, the knowledge about Allah’s laws can be acquired but nobody can know or conclude about the personae of Allah Himself. This is why the Quran has asked to believe in Allah and understand His attributes in order to use these as a model for the self-development. **Ibn Faris** has said that this root has two basic meanings i.e. two things to occur one after another and the other meaning is - peace and satisfaction.

“الْعُرْفُ” (*al-urfu*) or “الْعُرْفُ” (*al-uruf*): progeny of a horse because it has hair one after another or wave after wave.

“الْعَرْفُ” (*araf*) means to recognize, because an unknown thing causes consternation. If a thing gets recognized and is familiar then peace and satisfaction follows.

“الْعَرْفُ” (*al-arf*): good perfume.

“عَرَفَ” (*arafa*), “يَعْرِفُ” (*ya'rifu*), “مَعْرِفَةٌ” (*ma-rifatan*) and “عِرْفَانًا” (*irfana*) all mean to recognize something.

“مَعَارِفُ الْأَرْضِ” (*ma-ariful arz*): known and recognized paths of the earth {*T*}.

“تَعَارَفُوا” (*ta-arafu*): they recognized each other.

“أَمْرٌ عَرِيفٌ” (*amrun areef*): work that is recognized {*T, R*}.

“الْعَرِيفُ” (*al-areef*): to recognize one’s own men, or introduce them.

“التَّعْرِيفُ” (*at-tareef*): to introduce something {*T, R*}.

This word is used for a lofty thing as well.

“الْعُرْفُ” (*al-urf*): a high sand dune or some high place easy to recognize.

“الْأَعْرَفُ” (*al-arafu*): a high place, as well as the crop that is on both banks.

“قُلَّةٌ عَرَفَاءُ” (*qullatah arfa*): high peak.

“نَاقَةٌ عَرَفَاءُ” (*naaqatun arfa*): a she camel with a high back.

“الْعُرْفَةُ” (*al-urfah*): distinct border between two things {*T, R*}.

“اعْتَرَفَ بِذَنْبِهِ” (*itarafa bizambeh*): he owned up his sin, or he confessed to his sin {*T, R*} (41:11).
 “عَرَفَ فَلَانًا” (*arafa fulana*): so and so got punished for his crime {*T, R*}.
 “عُرِفَا” (*urfoona*): to come or follow another, or come one after another.
 “جَاءَ الْقَوْمُ عُرْفًا” (*ja’al qoumu urfa*): people came one after another. This led people to say that “وَالْمُرْسَلَاتِ” (*walmur-salati urfa*) in (77:1): angels who come one after another {*T, R*}.

The Quran has used “يَعْرِفُونَ” (*yarifoon*) against “يُنْكِرُونَ” (*yunkiroon*) in (16:83).
 Therefore “أَمَرَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ” (*amrun bil maroofi*) and “نَهَى عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ” (*nahi unil munkar*) has been said at many places as in (3:109).

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says “الْعُرْفُ” (*al-urf*) instead of “الْمَعْرُوفُ” (*al-maroofo*) in (7:199). “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*ma-roof*) means all those deeds or works which are accepted by a Quranic System, and “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) are all those deeds that are not accepted by such a system. These two are comprehensive terms of the Quran which incorporate all laws imposed by the Quran and also the daily practices of the members of a Quranic System. It is obvious that the basic principles that govern such customs and practices will remain unchanged because they have been fixed by the Quran, but their form and details shall be framed according to the times and these will keep changing with the changing requirements of the time. As such, the deeds and customs that a Quranic System accepts during an era are called “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*ma-roof*) whether these exist from the past or these have been suggested as new to meet the requirement of the time within the guidance of the Quran. This means that the customs and practices that it upholds in a Quranic System will also be considered “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*ma-roof*). But it must be ensured here that nothing among the customs and practices should be against the overall teachings of the Quran because in that case those will become “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*). See heading (*N-K-R*).

The Quran says:

7:46	And there will be men on heights, recognizing each other by their marks	وَعَلَى الْأَعْرَافِ رِجَالٌ يَعْرِفُونَ كُلًّا بِسِيمَاهُمْ
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Usually “أَعْرَافٌ” (*airaaf*) is taken to mean the place between heaven and hell. Those people, whose good and bad deeds will be equal, are called people of “أَعْرَافٌ” (*airaaf*), and it has not been decided whether they will go to heaven or hell. This is not the right meaning as the Quran mentions only two groups, that is “أَصْحَابُ الْجَنَّةِ” (*as-haabul jannata*) and “أَصْحَابُ النَّارِ” (*as-haabun naar*). There is no mention of any third group.

Secondly the loftiness of the people of “أَعْرَافٌ” (*airaaf*) is said to make them recognize people who will go to hell and heaven. Therefore this ‘loftiness’ which is the right meaning of “أَعْرَافٌ” (*airaaf*), tell us that this is the mention of people on higher places {*Ibn Qateebah* in *Al-Qartain* vol.1}.

People of “أَعْرَافٌ” (*al-airaaf*) are the loftiest people and these people will appear as witnesses for their groups (4:41). This group is probably that which has been called “السَّابِقُونَ” (*as-sabiquna*) and “الْمُقَرَّبُونَ” (*muqarraboona*) in (56:10-11). This is the group that has also been called “شُهَدَاءُ عَلَى النَّاسِ” (*shuhada’a alan naas*) in (2:143).

Among the rituals of *Hajj*, there is also mention of “عَرَفَاتٌ” (*arafaat*) in (2:198). This is the ground where Muslims of the whole world recognize each other or gather during *Hajj*.

Surah *Muhammad* says about a heavenly society:

47:6	the heaven which has been made pleasant for them { <i>R</i> }	عَرَفَهَا
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This can also mean that the heaven is quite familiar to them because the Quran has introduced it to them. *Ibn Faris* says it means that Allah has infused perfume or good fragrance in the paradise, but the meaning of mutual recognition and introduction are more appropriate for this word.

“عَرَامُ الْجَيْشِ” (*aramul jaish*): speed, force and large numbers of an army.
 “الْغَرَامُ مِنَ الرَّجُلِ” (*al-uram minar rajul*): impulsiveness and rudeness, and someone inflicting pain and hurt.
 “الْعَرِمُ” (*al-aram*): dams or other such constructions that are created in the valleys. It also means heavy rain which becomes intolerable {T, M, R}.

The Quran mentions “سَيْلُ الْعَرِمِ” (*sailul arim*) which means a very strong flood.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is hardness and intensity.

“عُرْوَةٌ” (*urwatah*): thorny bushes which have firm roots and which do not shed their leaves even in winter. Thus when there is no other plantation for animals to feed on, these bushes come in handy for them. These bushes can be relied on during all seasons. As such, anything that can be depended upon is called “عُرْوَةٌ” (*urwatah*). The handle of a bucket in a well is also called “عُرْوَةٌ” (*urwatah*) {T}. Any support that one can hang onto is “عُرْوَةٌ” (*urwatah*) {R}.

Ibn Faris says “عُرْوَةٌ” (*urwatah*) can also mean a button hole wherein a button can be fastened.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says that the belief as defined in the Quran i.e. in Allah is called “الْعُرْوَةُ الْوُثْقَى” (*urwatah wusqa*) in (2:256). This means a solid support that can be relied upon. A law of life that can never make a mistake in its result which is totally dependable regarding its authority, which never fails and never deceives, which never breaks midway, is hence called “عُرْوَةٌ” (*urwatah*).

“عَرَاهُ” (*arahu*), “إِعْتَرَاهُ” (*iterahu*): to come in front, i.e. that thing or reality became evident him without any obstruction whatsoever, or very clearly {R}.

“الْعُرْيُ” (*al-uryu*), “عَرَى” (*aria*), “يَعْرَى” (*ya'ra*), “عُرْيًا” (*oorban*): to become naked or to be naked {T}.

The Quran says “لَا تَعْرَىٰ” (*la yahra*) in (20:118) which means “you will not remain naked”, i.e. you will not have a want for clothes. Dress is one of the basic necessities that will be met in a heavenly society in addition to food and shelter (20:118-119).

“الْعَرَاءُ” (*al-araoo*): open space where there is no cover {T}.

The Quran says:

37:145	We put him in open ground	فَنَبَذْنَاهُ بِالْعَرَاءِ
68:49	They should surely have been thrown on the naked shore	نُبَذَ بِالْعَرَاءِ

“الْعَرَىٰ” (*al-ara*): corner, a corner of porch or wall.

“أَعْرَاءُ الْأَرْضِ” (*aarao al-ard*): raised portions of the earth {T}.

For more on “عَرَاهُ” (*arahu*) and “إِعْتَرَاهُ” (*i'tarah*), see heading (Ain-R-W).

“عَزَبَ” (*azoob*), “يَعْزُبُ” (*yazab*): disappear, become hidden, and go away.
 “الْمَعْزَابُ” (*al-mezaab*): a man who takes his herd away from all people.
 “الْعَزِيبُ” (*al-azeeb*): a man who goes far away from his family.
 “إِبِلٌ عَزِيبٌ” (*iblu azeeb*): camels which do not return home in the evening {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

10:61	nothing can remain hidden from you Sustainer	وَمَا يَعْزُبُ عَنْ رَبِّكَ--
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It means something which cannot go away, disappear, and go beyond the grip of the laws of Allah.

“الْعَزْرُ” (*al-azru*) basically means to stop or prevent one.
 “عَزَرْتُ الرَّجُلَ” (*azaratur rajul*): I stopped that man.
 “تَعْزِيرٌ” (*ta'zeer*): discipline. It means to punish someone to such an extent which is enough to discipline him so he may change his current conduct and behaviour. Since this discipline is for the betterment of someone, that is, to give him some time to correct his ways, it has a connotation of respect as well as punishment. Taj-ul-Uroos says it means to furnish power, or to help with either tongue or sword.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning include respect, punishment and victory.

The Quran says:

5:12	You helped them with respect	وَعَزَّزْنَاهُمْ
7:157	So those who believe him and honor him and help him	فَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا بِهِ وَعَزَّرُوهُ وَنَصَرُوهُ
48:9	That you believe in Allah, His messenger, and honor him and respect him.	لِتُؤْمِنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ وَتُعَزِّرُوهُ وَتُوَفِّرُوهُ

In these verses the believers have been exhorted to help their messenger and to respect him.

“تَعْزِيرٌ” (*azzeruhu*): to protect the messenger in such a way as to protect his message to mankind and also protect his person so that he is saved from all sorts of machinations of opposing people. Thus nothing should be allowed to be attributed to the messenger of Allah which demeans him in any way or reduces his respect among the people.

“الْعِزُّ” (*al-izzu*): power, intensity, overpowering and protection.
 “عِزَّةٌ” (*izzatun*): to develop such resistance that does not let anything overpower a man.

Kitab-ul-ashfaaq says that meaning of this word is solidity and intensity.

“اسْتَعَزَّ الرَّمْلُ” (*ista-azzar raml*): sand dune stayed in place and did not fall by becoming loose {*T, M*}.
 “الْمَعْزُوزَةُ” (*al-mauzoozah*): hard ground or that ground on which rain falls and solidifies its sand or soil.
 “تَعَزَّزَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*ta-azzatin naafah*): openings in a she camel's teats became narrow and the milk came out with difficulty.
 “تَعَزَّزَ اللَّحْمُ” (*ta-azzazal lahum*): meat or flesh that has hardened.
 “عَزَّهَ بَعُزُّهُ” (*azzaha ba-izzuh*): overpower someone due to one's power or hardness (38:23).
 “الْعَزِيزَةُ” (*al-azeezahu*): hawk {*T, M*}.
 “عَزَّ” (*azza*): became strong.
 “عَزَّزَهُ” (*az-zazahu*): gave him strength (39:12).

“عَزَّ عَلَىٰ أَنْ تَفْعَلَ كَذَا” (*azza alyya un taf-ala kaza*): it was very displeasing and discomforting for me to be asked to do this {*T, M*}.

This word has come against “زِلَّةٌ” (*zillatun*) in (3:25), which is said to mean “to get strength and authority”

The Quran says:

18:34	as per tribe and group, I am more authoritative	أَعَزُّ نَفَرًا
38:2	the opponents have been intoxicated with power and have started opposing the Quran in their stupor	هَيْفَىٰ عِزَّةٍ وَشِقَاقٍ
9:128	the thing that gives you pain hurts Him very much	عَزِيزٌ عَلَيْهِ مَا عَنِتُّمْ

The Quran has used “الْعَزِيزُ” (*al-azizu*) for Allah in (2:129) i.e. the overpowering authority of the universe belongs only to Allah, and there is no other power which can overpower His laws. In human society, such strength and authority can only accrue to a society which runs according to the laws of Allah (63:8). As has been said before, power and authority belongs to Allah alone, but He has made such laws which if followed by man, can give him power and authority on this earth. These laws are concerning the world as well as the social and collective life of man. The nation that follows these laws can attain power and authority. This is the meaning of (3:26) which means that Allah accords power and authority as per His laws and nothing can take place on its own. It also means that the Quran explains this process and this can be understood if intellect and reasoning is used.

Surah *Yusuf* uses “الْعَزِيزُ” (*al-azizu*) to mean the chief of that area (12:30), or someone with authority. The wife of this very chief had wanted to entice messenger *Yusuf*. This woman has not been named in the Quran. She has only been called “إِمْرَأَتُ الْعَزِيزِ” (*imra-atul azeez*) in (12:30), that is, the woman of the chief.

“الْعُزَّىٰ” (*al-uzza*) is the name of an idol which was worshipped during pre-Islamic era by the tribe of *Ghatfaan* (53:19).

Ain-Z-L ع ز ل

“عَزَّلَهُ عَنِ الْعَمَلِ” (*azzalahu unil amali*), “عَزَّلَهُ” (*azzalhu*): removed him from the job or task.
 “فَاعْزَلْ” (*fa-tazal*): so he left the job, i.e. was removed to one side.
 “مَعْزُولٌ” (*ma-zool*): that which had been removed.
 “الْعَزَلَةُ” (*al-uzlatah*): to leave or part from, separation.
 “الْإِعْزَالُ” (*al-itezaal*): something to part way.
 “الْعَزْلُ” (*al-azl*): to stop the sperm from reaching the ovary i.e. to stop insemination {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

18:16	When you left them	وَ إِذَا اغْتَرَ تَلْمِزُهُمْ
26:21	They were removed (stopped) from listening	إِنَّهُمْ عَنِ السَّمْعِ لَمَعْزُولُونَ
11:42	He was at a separate place, away from them	وَكَانَ فِي مَعَزِلٍ
33:51	Whom you had separated from	مِمَّنْ عَزَلْتَ
2:222	Stay away from wives during periods (do not go near them till their periods have ended)	وَلَا تَقْرُبُوهُنَّ حَتَّىٰ يَطْهُرْنَ

“إِعْتَزَمَ الرَّجُلُ” (*aatazamer rajul*): he stayed moderate during running, walking, and other things.
 “إِعْتَزَمَ الطَّرِيقَ” (*itazamat tareeq*): he kept on walking straight without turning to any side.
 “أَعْتَزَمَ عَلَيْهِ” (*a'tazam alai*), “أَعْتَزَمَ عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*azami alal amri*): decided finally to do something and then stayed firm.
 “عَزَمَ” (*azaam*) and “عَزِيْمَةٌ” (*aazeemah*): to stick to something firmly after deciding about it.
 “مَالِفُلَانٍ عَزِيْمَةٌ” (*maali fulanin azeematun*): that man never sticks to anything.
 “الْعَزَامُ” (*al-azzaam*): a man of decision.
 “الْعَزَمُ” (*al-azam*): to finally decide about something {F}.

The Quran says:

2:227	If they are firm on their decision to separate or divorce	وَ إِنْ عَزَمُوا الطَّلَاقَ
20:115	We did not find him to be decisive	وَلَمْ نَجِدْ لَهُ عَزْمًا
2:235	do not strengthen the knot of wedlock	وَلَا تَعَزِّمُوا عُقْدَةَ النِّكَاحِ
46:35	those with stolidity	أَوْ لَوْلَا الْعَزَمُ
42:43	those who are firm in their commitments	عَزَمَ الْأُمُورِ

The Quran says that the characteristic of all messengers and believers (momineen) is that they all are people of commitment and their aims are very lofty. However, as the it happens over a period of time nowadays “عَزِيْمَةٌ” (*azeemah*) means talisman and “عَزَائِمُ الْقُرْآنِ” (*azai'mul Quran*) means the verses of the Quran which are used for these talismans {R}. The meanings have changed quite contrary to the meanings used in the Quran.
 “الْمُعَزِّمُ” (*al-mu'azzim*): a person who prepares these talismans {R}.

“الْعِزَّةُ” (*al-izzah*): a band of people, a group or sect. The plural is “عِزُّونَ” (*e'zun*) and “عِزِينَ” (*e-zeen*) {T, M}. These words are used for groups that are motley and varied (70:37).

Raghib thinks that this word has led to the word “عَزَوْتُهُ” (*azautahu*) which means something referred to someone. Thus this word is used for a group which is said to be affiliated to someone. But it was again **Raghib** who presented a different thought that it has been culled from the word “عَزَاءٌ” (*azaoo*) which means to acquire patience and consolation {R}. Thus this word may mean a group which is quite at peace at being known to be of a certain belief etc. or a group in which its members find peace and consolation with each other.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this word is to be affiliated.

Surah *At-Tauba* says:

9:30	Jews claim that Uzair is the son of Allah	وَقَالَتِ الْيَهُودُ عُزَيْرٌ ابْنُ اللَّهِ
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Uzair enjoys great respect among the Jews. When the Jews returned to Jerusalem after their subjugation in Babylon, they had lost the collection of their Holy Books. Chapter 8 of the book *Yahmiyah* relates in detail the five books in the first series of the Torah which was compiled anew by **Azra nabi** or the so-called messenger. This information is included in the present day Torah wherein **Azra** has related how he compiled these books. This event is four hundred and fifty years before Christ. Details can be found in the book titled *Meraaji Insaniyat*, first Chapter named *Zaharul Fasaad*.

The Jewish literature contains quite exaggerated statements about **Azra**. The Jewish encyclopedia has gone so far as to say that if the messenger **Moses** had not been granted messenger-hood then **Azra** would have been chosen instead.

The Quran has not talked about him beyond this, nor has it mentioned his name among the messengers. As such, we cannot say, as the believers of the Quran, whether **Azra** was a messenger or not. The Jews used to call a big official of their temple as messenger whose name used to be **Kahaant**.

The origin or the parenthood of **Uzair** holds a big importance because the Jews challenge the Quran and say that they never accepted **Uzair** as the son of Allah. However there is a tale among us with reference to **Ibn Abbas** that some Jews in Medina city used to hold this belief. **Ibn Khurram** has written that the **Sadduqi** sect of the Jews which was based in Yemen had this belief {*Arzul Quran* by **Syed Sulaiman Naqvi**}. But the Jews refuse to believe this tale. The present day literature of the Jews also does not support this theory. Keeping the changing beliefs of the Jews and also of some Christians, it can be said that previously they may have held this belief but later gave it up and removed it from their literature. Plus the fact that we are witnessing facts about some historic truth every other day, so who can say what we may see in the days to come? In the face of this fact we can safely say that, like the dead body of the Pharaoh, after more research this belief of the Jews may come to light.

But recently researchers have found out that the **Uzair** whom the Jews thought to be a son of Allah is not **azra nabi** but Egyptian god Osiris who used to be worshipped there. And seeing them do it, the Jews also started worshipping him. Herodotus has named this god as Osiris about two and a half thousand year's back. In Greece, the sound of s after names is always additional. Therefore this god's name is **Uzair** which is just like the **Uzair** mentioned in the Quran. Its name in Egyptian mythology is **Ezari**. The ox worshipped in its name was called **Ezar Habi**. This ox was seen as the manifest of the soul of **Uzair** and used to be seen as avatar or earthly manifestation of the creative God, and son of Allah.

These beliefs had been passed on to Jerusalem after crossing Egyptian borders and it was this calf that was being worshipped in the absence of Moses and which is mentioned in the Quran. The messenger Moses had stopped the Jews from worshipping this calf, but after Moses it started to be worshipped again. Therefore after the division of the Jews state, the monarch of the northern state i.e. **Brobam** first declared the worship of the calf as the state religion in 933 BC and after creating two golden calves made it mandatory to be worshipped among the subjects. It is this **Uzair** god towards which the Quran has pointed. In current times the correction of the Hebrew version of the bible includes the mention of **Uzair** but by mistake the translation of **uzair** was done as **aseer** or prisoner. Now **Legard** has made the correction in his version with Greek translation.

The ruins of Egypt also show that **Uzair** is probably the first to be worshipped as the son of god. As about 4000 years ago this god was the son of God and was called "**amman rah**" and he was the son of the Earth god. Recently a scroll from Egypt has been recovered which mentions **Uzair** and his circumstances.

The above findings show that **Uzair** is the Egyptian god and not **azra nabi**. In any case these are historical guesses. It is possible that later more information may finally settle the debate.

“الْعُسْرُ” (*al-a'sru*): This word comes against “يُسْرٌ” (*yusr*) which means ease, openness, act freely. See heading (Y-S-R). Hence “عُسْرٌ” (*u'sr*) means difficulty, strictness, problematic condition, hardship, discomfort {T}.

Surah *Al-Furqan* says:

25:26	That day will be of a great difficulty for the deniers	وَ كَانَ يَوْمًا عَلَى الْكَافِرِينَ عُسْرًا
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Muheet says that “عُسْرٌ” (*u'sr*) is used when there is lack of openness in issues, or when there is stringency of conduct.

Surah *At-Talaq* says:

65:6	If you feel discomfort among yourselves.	وَ إِن تَعَاشَرْتُمْ
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Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is discomfort and hardship.

“قَدْ تَعَسَّرَ الْغَزْلُ” (*qad ta'assar*): yarn got tangled and did not get resolved.

“عُسْرَةٌ” (*u'sra*): uncomfortable and strict environment.

The Quran has declared that the best way to get ease and comfort is to stand up and face difficulties. He who does not face difficulties does not get to face comfort later (94:5). Life is the name of constant struggle. It does not mean that once you get comfort, you may get relaxed and stop struggling. One will even then have to face difficulties which one must try to overcome.

The Quran says:

94:5-6	Certainly along with harshness comes comfort	إِنَّ مَعَ الْعُسْرِ يُسْرًا
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“عَسَىَ اللَّيْلُ” (*a'sa'sal lail*): night came, or departed. Some have said that it means “to go by, or pass, to depart”. Some others have said that this word is among such words which also hold anti meaning of them. Therefore, it can mean “to come” as well as “to depart”. *Lataif-ul-Lugha* has also included this word in this category.

“الْعَسَسَةُ” (*al-a'asa'sah*): conditions of twilight. This condition appears when night is about to pass and morning is about to surface, or when daylight is losing its grip to the darkness of night {T}.

Ibn Faris says that “عَسَىَ” (*a'sa's*) only means for something to come. The word for something to pass is in fact “سَعَىَ” (*sa'sa'*).

“عَسَىَ الشَّيْءُ” (*a'sa'sash shayi*): It gave motion to that thing.

“عَسَىَ الذَّنْبُ” (*a'sa'saz zeeb*): the wolf wandered around at night.

The Quran says:

81:17	And darkness of night when it departs	وَاللَّيْلِ إِذَا عَسَسَ
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This must mean passing of darkness of night, because it is followed by:

81:19	This has been narrated to you by a most respected messenger.	وَالصُّبْحِ إِذَا تَنَفَّسَ
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This means that just like the laws of nature which are implemented by Allah and are unchangeable and firm, so are the truths and the values revealed in the Quran.

Ibn Faris has said that this root basically means distinction or disorder, as well as honey.

”رُمَحٌ عَسَالٌ” (*rumahun a’assal*): a flexible spear.

”الْعَسَلُ” (*al-a’sal*): air bubbles on surface of water that starts moving because of a breeze.

”عَسَلٌ” (*a’sal*): honey.

”الْعَسَالُ” (*al-a’ssal*): a person who takes down a honey bee hive.

”عَسَلَ اللَّهُ فَلَانَا” (*a’sal-allahu fulaan*): may Allah make that one person distinct among his fellows.

”الْعُسْلُ” (*al-a’slu*), ”الْعُسْلُ” (*al-a’nsal*): fast moving camel as compared to other camels.

”الْعُسْلُ” (*al-u’sul*): righteous people

”الْعَاسِلُ”

” (*al-a’sil*): a nice and sweet person who is distinctively praised with nice words.

”هُوَ عَلَى أَعْسَالٍ مِنْ أَبِيهِ” (*huwa a’ala a’salin min abyh*): he has his father's distinctive features.

The Quran says ”أَنْهَارٌ مِنْ عَسَلٍ مُصَفًّى” (*anharun min a’salim masaffa*) about the rivers of *jannah* in (47:15). Its general translation says “rivers of honey”. But as all these references are metaphoric, this may also mean pure, sweet and admirable attributes and characteristics of people. Even today we use phrases like “rivers of milk flow there” for societies where sustenance is available in abundance.

A’saa

عَسَى

This word is generally used in a meaning of being hopeful for an outcome. It is as we would say “may this happen like this” or “let us hope that this result like this”, or “it was possible that it may result like this”, or “it may have such an outcome”.

The Quran says:

17:79	It is very possible that your Sustainer may establish you on the place of great admiration.	عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَبْعَثَكَ رَبُّكَ مَقَامًا مَّحْمُودًا
66:5	It is very possible that if he may divorce you, his Sustainer provide him wives better than you.	عَسَىٰ رَبُّهُ إِنْ طَلَّقَكُنَّ أَنْ يُبَدِّلَهُ أَزْوَاجًا خَيْرًا مِنْكُنَّ
2:216	It is very possible that there may be a thing you do not favor, but which is in fact good for you.	عَسَىٰ أَنْ تَكْرَهُوا شَيْئًا وَهُوَ خَيْرٌ لَكُمْ
2:246	It is likely for you that you may not fight a war which you may be asked to fight	هَلْ عَسَيْتُمْ إِنْ كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْقِتَالُ أَلَّا تُقَاتِلُوا

This last verse may also be written like “it may not be probable that you ...”

Ain-Sh-R

ع ش ر

”الْعَشْرَةُ” (*al-a’sharah*), ”الْعَشْرُ” (*al-a’shru*): ten.

”الْعِشْرُونَ” (*al-ishroon*): twenty.

”الْعَشِيرُ” (*al-a’sheer*), ”الْعَشْرُ” (*al-ushur*): tenth part.

11:13	Bring forth ten surah	فَأَنشُرُوا بِعَشْرِ سُورٍ
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”عَاشُرُوا” (*a’shuru*): those people lived intermingled.

”مُعَاشِرَةٌ” (*mu’asharah*): a society of people living together.

”عَشِيرَةُ الرَّجُلِ” (*a’sheeratur rajul*): close relatives or the tribe of one’s father.

”الْمَعْشَرُ” (*al-ma’shara*): a group, a party of people.

”ذَبَبَ الْقَوْمَ عَشَارِيَاتٍ” (*zahabal qoumu usharayaat*), i.e. the nation was disintegrated {M}.

”عَشِيرَةٌ” (*asheeratah*): tribe, family, or those who live with you (26:214).

“الْعَشِيرُ” (*al-asheer*): companion or friend (22:13).
 “مَعْشَرٌ” (*ma'sher*): party, group (55:33).
 “مِمْشَارٌ” (*mi'shaar*): tenth part.
 “عِشَارٌ” (*ishaar*): a she camel with ten month old pregnancy (81:4) {F}.
 “عَاشَرَ” (*aashar*): to live together with amity (4:16).

Rabhib says that it means a group consisting of one's closest people.

Ibn Faris says it basically means ten, as well as intermingling with each other.

ع ش و / ی Ain-Sh-W/Y

“الْعِشَاءُ” (*al-asha*): darkness to fall before the eyes i.e. to become blind {T}.
 “عَاشَا عَنْهُ” (*asha unh*): he turned away from him and leaned towards another, avoided him {M}.

Surah **Az-Zakhrif** says:

43:36	he who turns his mind away from the laws of Rahman	وَمَنْ يَغْشُ عَنْ ذِكْرِ الرَّحْمَنِ
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Hence it means one who turns away from the laws of God (Rehman as an attribute).

Raghib says this means one who closes his eyes to the mention of Allah, i.e. turns a blind eye to His laws. Both mean the same thing i.e. to avoid the laws of Allah as per the Quran.

Ibn Faris says it basically means twilight or for light to become dimmer, and for something to become less clear.

“الْعِشَاءُ” (*al-isha*) generally means night, but it can be applied to several occasions, for example, the initial darkness from sunset to “عِشَاءُ” (*isha*) prayers. From the time the sun starts setting to the next dawn.
 “الْعِشْيُ” (*al-ashiyyu*) and “الْعِشْيَةُ” (*al-ashiyya*): last part of the day, that is, from sunset to total dark.
 “الْعِشْيُ” (*al-ashiyyu*): from the time the sun is on decline, to the next morning. From the time that the sun starts setting to the time of sunset.
 “عِشْيُ” (*ashiyyu*) is thought to be night because this matter contains “عِشَاءُ” (*isha*) meaning darkness. The evening meal is said to be “الْعِشَاءُ” (*al-isha-u*).
 “صَلَاةُ الْعِشْيِ” (*salatal ashiiyi*) means prayers of afternoon (*zuhr*) and late afternoon (*asr*).
 “الْعِشَاءُ أَنْ” (*al-isha-aan*) means the prayers of sunset (*maghrib*) and night (*isha*) {T}.

Surah **Aal-e-Imran** says:

3:41	And glorify Him during morning and evening	وَسَبِّحْ بِالْعِشْيِ وَالْإِبْكَارِ
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Here the word “عِشْيُ” (*ashiyyi*) has appeared against “إِبْكَارُ” (*ibkaar*) meaning the first part of the day.

Surah **An-Naaziat** says:

79:46	the last part of the day	عِشْيَةً أَوْ ضُحًى
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Surah **Saad** has used the word “عِشْيُ” (*ashiyyi*) in (38:31) to mean the later part of the day.
 Surah **Ar-Rome** has used “عِشْيًا” (*ashiyya*) with “حِينَ تُظْهِرُونَ” (*heena tazharoon*) in (30:18).
 Surah **Yusuf** has simply used “عِشَاءُ” (*isha*) in (12:16), which may be late part of an evening, i.e. night.
 In Surah **An-Noor** “مِنْ قَبْلِ صَلَاةِ الْفَجْرِ” (*min qabli salat al fajar*) before the morning prayer has appeared against “مِنْ بَعْدِ صَلَاةِ الْعِشَاءِ” (*min baadi salat al isha*) i.e. after the night prayer (24:58).

Ibn Faris says it means to fasten something with something else length wise or around it.

“الْعَصْبُ” (*al-asb*): muscles of body, especially those around joints. It also means best men in a society.

“عَصَبٌ” (*asb*) basically means to twist or ravel. It also means to fasten tightly.

“عَصَبَ الشَّجَرَةَ” (*asabus shajara*): various branches of the tree were fastened by a rope and then the tree was shaken to make it shed its leaves.

“الْعَصَابَةُ” (*al-isabah*): a bandage which is wrapped around {*T, R*}.

“الْأَمْرُ الْعَصِيبُ” (*al-amrul asseeb*): a hard contest {*T, R*}.

“هَذَا يَوْمٌ عَصِيبٌ” (*haaza yaumun aseeb*): this is a hard day (11:77).

Raghib says it signifies a day which is hard on somebody from every side or in every way, or which is impossible or difficult for one to avoid.

“الْعَصِيَّةُ” (*al-asabiyya*): for one to call on people to help his family and to support his party or group, whether this support is right or wrong.

“عُصْبَةٌ” (*asabatun*): party or group, or people who are bound together with a common cause {*T, R*}.

The Quran says that the brothers of messenger **Yusuf** said:

12:8	we are veritable group by ourselves, we lend moral strength to each other	نَحْنُ عُصْبَةٌ
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Ibn Faris has written with reference to **Khalil** that this word is used for a group comprising of at least ten men, and it is not applicable to a lesser number.

According to **Ibn Faris**, “عَصْرٌ” (*asr*) has three meanings:

- 1) Time or era.
- 2) To press or squeeze something.
- 3) To get very close to latch on to something.

“عَصَرَ الْعِنَبَ” (*asarat inb*): squeezed the grapes {*T*}.

Surah **Yusuf** says:

12:36	I have seen myself distilling alcohol	إِنِّي أَرَأَيْتُ أَعْصِرُ خَمْرًا
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Also see (12:49)

“الْعَصْرُ” (*al-asr*) may mean day, night, morning or evening time till the sun sets. It also means any long period during which a nations ends with their going into oblivion age or period {*T*}.

Kitab-ul-Ashfaaq has said it means an era.

The Quran says:

103:1 103:2	History is witness to the fact that the man who doesn't follow the revelation always loses	وَالْعَصْرِ إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لَفِي خُسْرٍ
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“الْعَصْرُ” (*al-asr*): to prevent or to stop, i.e. the limits of time within which some event is prevented.

“الْعَصْرُ” (*al-asr*): tribe or family {*T*}, as well as a sanctuary {*F*}.

“الْأَعْصَارُ” (*al-aisaar*): a hot wind that is very severe (2:266).

“الْمُعْصِرَاتُ” (*al-moseraat*): clouds or winds that bring clouds or clouds that shed rain {*T, M, F*} (78:15).

Lataif-ul-Lugha has written that:

“الْمُغْصِرَاتُ” (*al-moseraat*) means winds that bring rain-

“الْمُبَشِّرَاتُ” (*al-mubash-shiraat*) means winds that bring clouds.

ع ص ف Ain-Sd-F

“الْعَصْفُ” (*al-asf*): vegetables of a field or leaves of the plants in a field that dry up and fall down in small pieces. It also means leaves of the stems of plants, or leaves in a ploughed field. It also means husk of the grains, as well as the grain itself.

The Quran says about fellows of ‘*Feel*’:

105:5	like chewed husk (they were reduced to rubble or dust)	كَعَصْفٍ مَّاكُولٍ
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Kulyaat says that leaves of all plants are called “عَصْفُ” (*asfun*). It is this that produces the grains. The first part is when leaves can be seen, then the stem takes shape and then the fruits or grains are produced (55:12) {*M*}.

It is in this context that the Quran has said:

55:12	The grains which are within the husk	وَالْحَبُّ ذُو الْعَصْفِ
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Some say this refers to those leaves of the stems which dry up and later turn into dust {*T*}.

Raghib writes that anything which may have fallen off the plantation is called “عَصْفُ” (*asfun*) {*R*}.

“الْمُغْصِفَاتُ” (*al-mosefaat*): winds that bring with them clouds and leaves of trees and so on. It also means a heavy wind.

“رِيحٌ طَيِّبَةٌ” (*rabi-oon aasif*): a fast travelling wind or windstorm (10:22). Against this is said “رِيحٌ عَاصِفَتِيْزٌ” (*reehun tayyebah*), which means “a pleasant wind” e.g. breeze.

Surah **Al-Murselaat** says:

77:2	wind that blows away light material, or dust, or dry leaves	فَالْمُصِفَاتِ عَصِفًا
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“الْعَصْفُ” (*al-asf*) also means speed {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says that speed is the real meaning of this word.

Lataif-ul-Lugha says “الْعَوَاصِفُ” (*al-awasifu*) means those strong winds that stir up storms in desert or sea.

“الْقَوَاصِفُ” (*al-awasif*): winds that stir up a storm in sea.

“عَصْمَةٌ” (*ismatun*) actually means to stop or prevent. It also means to secure something. The plural is “أَعْصَامٌ” (*aa-saam*) which also means the muscles in the neck.
 “الْعِصَامُ” (*al-esaam*) means that rope of a saddle with which the saddle is secured on a camel's back. Two such ropes are called “عِصَامَانِ” (*eesamaan*).
 “الْعِصَامُ مِنَ الدَّلْوِ وَالْقِرْبَةِ” (*al-esaamu minad dalwi wal qirbah*) is the rope of a well bucket which is used to lower and raise the bucket to draw out water.
 “عَصَمَ الشَّيْءَ يَعْصِمُهُ” (*asamash shaiya yahsemooh*): stopped or prevented something.
 “عَصَمَهُ اللَّهُ مِنَ الْمَكْرُوهِ” (*asamahul laahu minal makrooh*): Allah protected him from an unpleasant thing and saved him.
 “عَصَمَ إِلَهِي” (*asama ilahi*) and “إِعْتَصَمَ بِهِ” (*i'samah behi*) means to hold on to something very strongly. This is what “إِعْتَصَامٌ” (*i'tesaam*) also means.

According to *Ibn Faris* “إِعْتَصَمَ بِاللَّهِ” (*i'tasamah billahi*) means to come under Allah's protection and be safe.
 “أَعَصَمَ بِفُلَانٍ” (*aasama bifulaan*): he latched on to him and stuck to him.
 “أَعَصَمَ بِالْفَرَسِ” (*aasama bil faras*): he held on to the horse's mane so that the rider would not fall off due to a sudden stop {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris says the root of this word means to catch or hold on to something and stick to it.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:100	anybody who holds firmly on to the laws of Allah finds the way to a straight path (balanced life)	وَمَنْ يَعْصِمْ بِاللَّهِ فَقَدْ هَدَىٰ إِلَىٰ صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ
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The same is the meaning noted in (3:102)

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:67	O messenger, keep spreading this message to people steadfastly. He shall protect you from (antagonistic) people	وَاللَّهُ يَعْصِمُكَ مِنَ النَّاسِ
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It is obvious that this verse is not talking about the physical protection of the messenger because it has been said at another place that:

3:134	if he is murdered or dies	أَفَايُنْ مَاتَ أَوْ قُتِلَ
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This means that the possibility of him being killed is very much there, and as such this verse (5:67) does not point to the messenger's physical protection but the protection of the message of Allah he carried.

“اسْتَعْصَمَ” (*aasim*): someone who protects (11:23).
 “اسْتَعْصَمَ” (*is'taasama*): he wanted to protect himself (12:32).

Ibn Faris says “إِعْتَصَمَ” (*istasama*) means that he avoided or shielded himself from something.

“عِصَمٌ” (*i'saam*) is the plural of “عِصْمَةٌ” (*ismah*) and means the wedlock (60:10), i.e. women who are married to you but do not want to turn into Muslims may be allowed to free themselves from the wedlock.

The basic meaning of “عَصَا” (*asa*) is congregation. It is also used for a staff, because in order to hold a staff, all fingers of a hand have to come together.

“عَصَوْتُ الْقَوْمَ” (*asautul qoum*): I gathered the people, or nation.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “الْعَصَا” (*al-asaa*) means an Islamic group.

“شَقَّ الْعَصَا” (*shaqqul asaa*): to create differences within a group, while Raghīb says it means to leave a group.

“الْقَى الْمُسَافِرُ عَصَاهُ” (*alqal musafiru asahu*): a traveler laid down his walking stick to indicate that he had reached his destination and now he must rest {T, R}.

The author of *Lataif-ul-Lugha* says “الْعَصَا” (*al-asaa*) means the same as “مَعْنَى الْوَيْلُ” (*al-wabeel*) i.e. acute.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says that messenger *Moses* was told:

2:60	Take your people to the hilly area.	إِضْرِبْ بِعَصَاكَ الْحَجَرَ
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Another meaning of this verse is “hit rocks with your staff and this will remove the mud on it and clean water will start flowing”.

In the same way it was said:

26:62	Take your group towards the sea	إِضْرِبْ بِعَصَاكَ الْبَحْرَ
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It may also mean “using your staff take the path to the sea”.

The staff of *Moses* has been mentioned often in the Quran, for example in (20:18). If this word is taken literally then it would mean staff. But if the figurative meaning of this phrase is taken, then it would mean the rule of Allah or the message of Allah which was the keynote of the messenger's life. It was the means of strength for the Muslims, and compared to which the misguided education and way of life of the Pharaoh did not carry any weight. In this way these verses of the Quran can be interpreted in the light of the relevant context and subject.

“عَصَى” (*asa*), “يَعْصِي” (*yasi*), “عِصْيَانًا” (*isyana*), “مَعْصِيَةً” (*ma'siyah*): to be rebellious, or to be disobedient {T}.

20:121	Adam was rebellious of his Rabb (Sustainer)	وَعَصَى آدَمُ رَبَّهُ
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“الْعَاصِي” (*al-aasi*): camel kid that does not follow its mother and goes hither and thither {T}.

“عَصَى الطَّائِرُ” (*asat taa'ero*): bird flew away.

“عَصَى الْعُرْقُ” (*asal irq*): blood kept flowing from the vein {M}.

“إِعْتَصَبَتِ النَّوَاهُ” (*i'tasatin nawah*): the kernel became hard.

“نَعَصَى الْأَمْرُ” (*ta'assal amr*): the matter became intense {T}.

The above examples make the meaning of “الْعِصْيَانُ” (*al-isyaaan*) clear.

Surah *Al-Hijraat* says those believers who hate denial and rebellion are “الرَّاشِدُونَ” (*ar-raashiduun*) (49:7) i.e. on the right path as suggested by Allah.

Surah *Al-Mujadala* says “مَعْصِيَةِ الرَّسُولِ” (*ma'siyatir rasul*) in (58:8) i.e. to be rebellious of the messenger has been prohibited.

In Surah *Maryam* “عَصِيًّا” (*asiyya*) has come to mean unfaithful (19:14).

Lataif-ul-Lugha has said that sometimes “مَعْصِيَّةً” (*ma'siyat*) can be applicable to some error also. The fact is that those who follow the laws of Allah tread the right path, and those who divert from this right path pursue a very destructive life. This is “مَعْصِيَّةً” (*ma'siyah*).

Raghib has said that “عَصَى” (*asa*) means to move out of obedience and this is because anyone who is unfaithful tries to defend himself with a staff. Moreover the man who defects from his party or group is said to be “فَلَانٌ شَقَّ الْعَصَا” (*falanun shaqqal asa*). This led to “عَصَى” (*asa*) meaning unfaithful {R}, but this reasoning doesn't seem right. For “عَصَاً” (*asaa*), see heading (Ain-Sd-W).

Ain-Zd-D ع ض د

“الْعُضُدُ” (*al-azdu*): part of an arm from the elbow to the shoulder, in other words, upper arm.

“عَضَدَهُ” (*majazan azadah*): helped him, assisted him.

“الْعُضُدُ” (*al-azadu*): a supporter or one who helps, i.e. right hand man of someone {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

18:51	I was not one to make them lead astray my helper or my right hand man	وَمَا كُنْتُ مُتَّخِذَ الْمُضِلِّينَ عُضُدًا
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“أَعْضَادُ الْحَوْضِ وَغَيْرِهِ” (*aazaadul hauziwa ghairihi*): the protective paraphernalia around a pool.

Ain-Zd-Zd ع ض ض

“عَضَّ” (*azza*): hold on to something with teeth, to bite using teeth.

“عَضَّ عَلَى يَدِهِ غَيْظًا” (*azza ala yadehi gaiza*) is said when someone has very antagonistic feeling towards another and commits excesses in vengeance {T}.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:118	their anger towards you is so intense that they bite their own fingers in anger	عَضُّوا عَلَيْكُمْ الْأَئِمْلَ مِنْ الْغَيْظِ
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This proverb is used when somebody hurts himself in anger because he can do no harm to his opponent.

Ain-Zd-L ع ض ل

“الْعِضْلَةُ” (*al-azalatu*): a muscle with thick flesh attached to it, as the muscles in the shin or arm {T}.

“عَضَلْتُهُ” (*azaltuhu*): I struck his muscle. Later it started meaning “stopping someone from doing something with force”.

“فَلَا تَعْضُلُوهُمْ” (*fala ta'zulau hunna*): do not stop them (2:232). It also means to bother or force someone into doing something {T}.

“عَضَلَ عَلَيْهِ” (*azala alaihi*): he deprived him or prevented him or stopped him.

“الْمُعْضِلَاتُ” (*al-mozelaat*): this means complex problems which cannot be solved. It also means hardship or misery {T}.

Ibn Faris says that basic meaning of this root is of misery and complexity.

“الْعُضْوُ” (*al-uzu*) or “الْعِضْوُ” (*a-izu*): a part of a human body {*T*}. It could mean a hand, nose, ear or leg etc. It may also mean a member of a group, an individual belonging to a party {*M*}.

Ibn Faris says this word means to divide something into parts.

“الْتَّعْصِيَةُ” (*ut-ta'ziyah*): to split into parts or to divide, to alienate one from the other.

“الْعِصَّةُ” (*al-iza*) is a piece of something, a sect.

“عِصْوَةٌ” (*iswatoon*) initially meant lies. The plural forms are “عِصْوُونَ” (*izoon*) and “عِصِيْنٌ” (*izeen*). This can also be the plural of “عِصَه” (*izah*) which means sorcery.

“الْعَاضِيَةُ” (*al-aazihu*) means a sorcerer {*T*}, probably because sorcery is performed with the help of a piece of flesh or bone.

Surah **Al-Hijr** says:

15:91	those who divided the Quran or cut it into pieces	الَّذِينَ جَعَلُوا الْقُرْآنَ عِضِينَ
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Ibn Qateebah says that this word is used for those who accept whatever suits them and reject whatever does not suit them. They create self-made laws for things they do not like. The result of such practice can be comprehended from (2:85). This verse says that they used the Quran only for reciting it as some sort of mantra, but not reading it to act upon its sayings.

“عِطْفٌ” (*i'tf*): towards one side.

Ibn Faris says this word basically means to take a turn or become crooked.

“عِطْفَا الرَّجُلِ” (*itfar rajul*): both sides of a man.

“عِطْفَا كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*itfa kulli shaiyee*): on both sides of everything.

“الْعِطْفُ” (*al-atf*): to return, or to take a turn {*T*}.

Raghib says this is said when one end of something is turned towards the other end.

The Quran says:

22:9	while avoiding it	ثَانِي عِطْفِهِ
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“عِطْفٌ” (*ataf*), “يَعِطِفُ” (*ya'tif*) or “عِطْفَاءٌ” (*atfa*) means to lean or to favor one side.

“الْعَاطِفَةُ” (*al-aatifa*): kindness, blessing etc. {*T*}.

“عِطْلٌ” (*atalun*), “عُطُولٌ” (*u'tuul*): to be devoid of jewelry.

“عِطْلَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ” (*atilatil mar'a*): the woman became devoid of jewelry.

Such a woman is called “الْعَاطِلُ” (*al-aatilu*) or “الْعُطْلُ” (*al-utul*).

“الْمِعْطَالُ” (*al-me'taal*): a woman who is usually without jewelry.

“النَّعْطِيلُ” (*at-tateel*): to be empty, to leave something after making it useless.

“الْعِطْلَةُ” (*al-atilar*): the well bucket which has broken ropes and which cannot be used for fetching water from the well.

“قَوْسٌ عِطْلٌ” (*qausoon utul*): the bow which is not taut.

“بَيْعَرٌ مُعْطَلَةٌ” (*berun mu-attalatun*): the well which has become useless as there is no population near it and it is no more used for drawing water {*T, R*} (22:45).

Surah *At-Takweer* says:

81:5	when pregnant camels will be abandoned as useless	إِذَا الْعِشَارُ عُطِّلَتْ
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“الْعِشَارُ” (*al-ishaarr*): she camels which are near child birth. The camels had great importance for the Arabs in those days and she camels which were about to give birth to baby camels were of course very important, and to leave alone such camels as useless means that in that era camels would be bereft of their significance.

“عُطِّلَ الْأَجِيرُ” (*atalal ajeer*): an unemployed laborer {*M*}.

ع ط و Ain-Te-W

“الْعَطْوُ” (*al-atwu*): to take or receive, to rise hands and head upwards in order to receive something.

“طَبَى عَطْوُ” (*zabyun atwun*), “طَبَى عِطْوُ” (*zabyun itwun*) and “طَبَى عَطْوُ” (*zabyun utwun*): deer which raises its head to eat off leaves of a tree {*T, R*}.

“الْإِعْطَاءُ” (*al-ita'o*): to give.

“الْعَطَاءُ” (*al-ata'o*) and “الْعَطِيَّةُ” (*al-attiyyah*): whatever that is given.

Some people differentiate between “إِيْتَاءُ” (*eetaoo*) which means to give, and “إِعْطَاءُ” (*i'ta'u*) and say that the former word is said when an obligation is met, but the later one is only said when something is given without any obligation {*T, R*}.

“الْإِعْطَاءُ” (*al-i'taoo*): to hand over something to someone.

“أَعْطَى الْبَعِيرُ” (*a't al-ba'eer*): the camel stopped being wild and became tame (gave up resistance).

“قَوْسٌ عَطْوَى” (*qausoon atwa*): a bow that can be stretched easily (gave up its resistance) {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

92:5	there is no bar on things which have been provided free of cost by your Rabb (Sustainer)	وَمَا كَانَ عَطَاءُ رَبِّكَ مَحْظُورًا
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Therefore when Allah has provided the means of sustenance free of cost then nobody has the right to bar these things from others by commercializing them, as it is done at present and has been done for centuries in the past. That is why Allah has said for those who establish the system of sustenance- ‘those who help others with a view to protect themselves, there is an easy path for them (92:5) and opposite to this:

92:8	one who gathers all for himself and deprives others – there are difficulties for him	مَنْ يَخْلُ وَاسْتَعْنَى
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In this way he wants to be free of others or independent but faces difficulty after difficulty.

It is obvious that the growth of any human body depends on the things one eats or drinks. It is not possible that one eats and the growth is seen in another body. But in contrast the human personality develops with anything that a person gives willingly for the good of others He does so quite happily and voluntarily. This is called “إِعْطَاءُ” (*i'taa*). This is the very basis of the Quranic message, that is to work as hard as possible to earn, and after taking whatever is required from the fruits of that labor that are essential to one's life, give away the rest for the development of a society. This is how the party of believers should behave. This can only work effectively within the framework of a system established within the permanent values of the Quran.

“الْتَّعَاطَى” (*at-ta'aati*) means to take something which one doesn't have the right to take. It also means to struggle, to take such a thing, to stand on the end of one's feet and extend the hand in trying to take something, or to make a big effort {*T*}.

About the man who killed the she camel which was let free by the messenger *Saleh*, it is said:

54:29	he made a big and courageous effort and extended his hand to kill the camel	فَتَّعَاطَى فَعَمَّرَ
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Ibn Faris says it means to achieve something on which one had no right.

Ain-Ze-M ع ظ م

- “عَظْمٌ” (*azm*): the bone in a human body which has a fundamental importance.
 “عَظْمُ الْفَدَّانِ” (*azmul faddaan*): the broad wooden strip of a farmer’s plough which is fitted with an iron grate in front which enjoys a central importance.
 “عَظَمَاتُ الْقَوْمِ” (*azamatul qoum*): chiefs or authority holders in a tribe.
 “عَظْمُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*azamut tareeq*): wider part of a road, because it holds greater significance.
 “عَظَمَةٌ” (*azamatun*): pride, loftiness, respect.
 “الْعَظِيمَةُ” (*al-azeematu*): a hard incident that is encountered {T}.

Ibn Faris says that this root means to be great and strong.

The Quran has used the word “عَظْمٌ” (*azmun*) at several places. Plurals are “عِظَامٌ” (*izaam*) and “أَعْظُمُ” (*aazum*). It means that bones in a human body have a basic importance, for example in (17:49), (16:43), (36:78), and (75:3).

Surah An-Noor uses “عَظِيمٌ” (*azeem*) to mean “importance” against “بَيْنٌ” (*hayyin*), which means “something not so important” (24:15).

- “النَّبَأُ الْعَظِيمُ” (*an-naba’il azeem*): big incident or great revolution (78:2).
 “الْقُرْآنُ الْعَظِيمُ” (*al-quranil azeem*): code of basics in human life (15:87).

With reference to “عَظْمُ الْفَدَّانِ” (*azmil faddaan*), the Quran is the code with the help of which the human life full of conflicts can be made pleasureable just like the barren land which can be brought under cultivation to make it productive. This can help to turn the narrow lanes into a highway which extends into the next life and becomes wider with the passage of time.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says about Allah:

2:256	the possessor of greatness and loftiness and the provider of loftiness and greatness to human beings	وَهُوَ الْعَلِيُّ الْعَظِيمُ
9:129	Sustainer of the great universe with the control at the fundamental level	رَبُّ الْعَرْشِ الْعَظِيمِ

Ain-F-R ع ف ر

- “الْعَفْرُ” (*al-afer*): clay, dust.
 “عَفَرَهُ فِي التُّرَابِ” (*aafarah fitturabi*), “يَعْفُرُهُ” (*bafirhu*): covered him in mud, buried him in dust.
 “الْمَعْفُورُ” (*al-ma’fuur*): anything which has been covered with mud.
 “الْعَفْرُ” (*al-ufr*) means fat, or strong. It also means a brave and active man.
 “عَفْرِيٌّ” (*ifreet*), “عَفْرِيْنٌ” (*ifir-reen*), “عَفْرِيْنٌ” (*wa-ifreen*), “رَجُلٌ عَفْرٌ” (*rajalun ifrun*): clever and mischievous person. It means someone who is very clever, sharp and has exceptional intelligence. It also means a man with great perseverance, or a strong man who can prevail upon his opponent {T, M, R}.

Surah **An-Namal** says “عَفْرِيَّتٌ مِنَ الْجِنِّ” (*ifreet minal jinn*) about a man in the court who is very strong and very clever individual from among the tribal people who had the capacity to enter or understand matters imperceptibly with his intelligence (27:39). Hence it means a man with great capacity to understand and handle things.

Ifreet عَفْرِيَّتٌ

This was the name of a chief of a tribe who was very strong among the army of the messenger **Suleiman** (27:39). He was very clever and a man of understanding. See heading (Ain-F-R).

“الْعِفَّةُ” (*al-iffa*) means the state of a libido where it can be protected from temptation {R}.

“عِفَّةٌ” (*iffah*) or “عَفَافٌ” (*afafoon*) means to prevent oneself from forbidden or haram things, or to abstain or stop oneself from forbidden things {M, T}. *Ibn Faris* has also supported this contention

“إِعْتَقَتِ الْإِبِلُ الْيَبَسَ” (*e'taffatil ibilul yabees*): camels picked up grass with their tongues after rubbing these with dust. There is a connotation of stopping oneself from something is in the basic meaning of this word.

“الْعَفَافَةُ” (*al-ufafatu*): little milk that remains in the teats of camels after being milked {M, T}.

“عَفَّ الرَّجُلُ” (*a'ffarrajulu*): man stopped himself from something inappropriate.

“تَعَفَّفَ” (*ta'affuf*): to be content with very little, or to prevent one's libido and stay away from temptations, or to shy away from despicable things and not to ask for help even when the need is there due to inner self-respect (2:203).

The Quran says:

24:60	if they are also careful about this then it is commendable	وَأَنْ يَسْتَعْفِفْنَ
22:23	those who do not find the means to enter wedlock should still stay away from temptation	وَلْيَسْتَعْفِفِ الَّذِينَ لَا يَجِدُونَ نِكَاحًا

It is this which is called “عَفْتُ” (*iffat*), or purity.

The Quran lays great emphasis on chastity i.e. it permits only one form of sexual relationship and that is through wedlock (formal mutual agreement). Aside from this, sexual contact is deemed to be a crime (against one own self and also in social context). The Quran allows a person in an emergency situation to eat that which is normally not permitted to be eaten, to the extent that it may save a life, but in sexual matters it does not consider this any emergency. Hunger and thirst are desires that are not under the control of human emotions but sexual emotions arise from one's own thoughts. If this is not thought about then sexual urges never arise. Therefore emergency situation does not apply in situations where a person can exercise his control and can use his free will.

“عَفُوٌ” (*afwu*) literally means ‘to give something up’.

“عَفَا عَنْهُ” (*afa unhu*): allowed him to go without punishment, i.e. forgave him {M, T}.

The Quran uses the words “عَفُوٌ” (*afwu*) and “صَفَحَ” (*safhu*) together in one sentence (2:109). The difference between these two words is that “صَفَحَ” (*safhu*) is quite comprehensive i.e. to allow going scot free, but in “عَفُوٌ” (*afwu*) it is possible that some advice may be given {T}.

Muheet says the difference between “عَفُوٌ” (*afwu*) and “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*) is that in “غُفْرَانٌ” (*ghufran*) there is no punishment whatsoever, while “عَفُوٌ” (*afwu*) can take place before or after a punishment.

“عَفُوٌ” (*afwu*) after a punishment would mean to remove the effects of the punishment, because “عَفُوٌ” (*afwu*) also means to remove/eliminate, and “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghirrat*) means to protect from the effects of punishment from the beginning.

“عَفُوٌ” (*afwu*): to remove or be removed.

“عَفَا أَرْءُهُ” (*afa aasaruh*): he was killed, or all traces of him were removed.

“الْعَفَاءُ” (*al-aga-u*): rain which washes away all traces {T}.

“عَفْوُ الْمَالِ” (*afwu maal*) means the wealth that is more than one's needs {Sahaa}

“أَعْطَيْتُهُ عَفْوُ الْمَالِ” (*aatai-tuhu afwu maal*): I gave him wealth without his asking for it {T, F}.

“الْعَفْوُ مِنَ الْمَاءِ” (*al-afwu minal maal*): the remaining water after which everyone has quenched their thirst.

“أَسْعُرُ الْبَعِيرِ” (*asha'ul ba'eer*): camels hair grew longer than needed.

“عَفَا عَلَيْهِ فِي الْعِلْمِ” (*afa alaihi fil ilm*): he surpassed him in knowledge and added to it.

“عَفَا الصُّوفَ” (*aas oof*): to cut wool after increasing it {T}.

Lataif-ul-Lugha has said that it has a double meaning i.e. “to remove” as well as “to increase”. Therefore it means “more than needed”.

The Quran says that these people inquire as to how much they should keep for themselves and how much they should spend towards the sustenance of others (2:219). The answer is “قُلِ الْعَفْوَ” (*qul afwu*) i.e. tell them “whatever that exceeds their own needs”. This is the true principal of Islamic sustenance, i.e. every individual in society should strive as hard as he can and keep for himself only that which he needs, and spend the rest for the betterment of the society at large. As against this the capitalist system is based on spare wealth or surplus money. But in a Quranic system, spare wealth cannot remain with any individual because it is handed over for the sustenance of others. All individuals are looked after by the system for their needs. Individuals hand over their surplus money to the system or state, and as such nobody dies of hunger and nobody possesses extra wealth. This eliminates the problems associated with the accumulation of wealth and which is the main cause of disparity and mutual conflicts.

“الْعَافِيَةُ” (*al-aafiyatu*) and “الْمُعَافَاةُ” (*al-mu’afaat*) means to protect from external harm, or to be protected from diseases and misery {T}.

Ibn Aseer says this sentence means that people are made independent of each other, or that nobody is dependent on another. Hence it means to protect one from harmful effects of another so that nobody is dependent on you, and vice versa.

“الْمُعَفَّى” (*al-mu’affi*): a man who stays with you, but does not expect anything from you {T}.

“أَعْطَيْتُهُ عَفْوَاً” (*aatai-tuhu afwa*): he gave him without asking.

“عَفْوَ” (*afwun*): best thing, or the thing which does not require any tribulation or effort in acquiring {T}.

After relating the mistakes of **Bani-Israel**, it is said in Surah **Al-Baqrah**:

2:5	it removed the effects of that error	ثُمَّ عَفَوْنَا عَنْكُمْ
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This is called overlooking or forgiving. It must be noted that the effects can be removed by undertaking some good work, the good results of which will replace the effects of any mistakes. See heading (S-N-N) and (S-W-A).

It has been used for giving up one’s rights in (2:237). This word has come to mean “go ahead” in (7:95), that is, they increased in number or developed themselves.

Surah **Ash-Shura** says:

42:40	The principle of justice demands that punishment should always be befitting the crime, but if the prosecutor forgives, and in this way paves the way for the reform of the criminal, then Allah will repay such a person.	وَجَزَاءُ سَيِّئَةٍ سَيِّئَةٌ مِّثْلُهَا فَمَنْ عَفَا وَأَصْلَحَ فَأَجْرُهُ عَلَى اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ لَا يُحِبُّ الظَّالِمِينَ
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Thus justice means repentance or reform. Vengeful punishment is awarded only when there is no chance of the above two conditions. Regarding the forgiveness of sins, see heading (T-W-B), (Gh-F-R) and (H-S-N).

“الْعُقْبُ” (*al-aqbu*), “الْعَاقِبُ” (*al-aqibu*), “الْعَاقِبَةُ” (*al-aaqibah*), “الْعُقْبَةُ” (*al-uqbah*), “الْعُقْبَى” (*al-uqbaay*): all these words mean the end or result of something. This is the basic meaning of this root. All other meanings are derivatives from this basic meaning.

“الْعُقْبُ” (*al-aqibu*): the heel. Plural is “أَعْقَابُ” (*aaqaab*) {T}. It also means progeny, the generation that follows e.g. sons or grandsons.

“الْعَاقِبُ” (*aal-aaqibu*): everything that replaces another or comes after it, or the officer who replaces the chieftain.

“عَقِبَهُ” (*aqabah*): he was his successor.

“تَعَاقَبَ الْمُسَافِرَانِ عَلَى الدَّابَّةِ” (*ta-aqabal musafiraana alad da-abbah*): two travellers mounted their horse's back one after another, since each comes after another. Therefore this word also means taking turn.

“الْعُقْبَةُ” (*ta-qeebun*): can mean day as well as night, this is because they both follow each other. Hence it also means to take turn or alternate as well.

“تَعَقَّبَ” (*ta'qeeb*): to look hither and thither, or turn and look back, or turn back.

“تَعَقَّبَ” (*ta'qqaboon*): to follow someone. It also means to arrest someone for a crime and punish him {T}.

Raghib says that “الْعُقْبُ” (*uqbu*) and “الْعُقْبَى” (*al-uqba*) means specifically good return.

“عَاقِبَةُ” (*aaqibah*), “عِقَابُ” (*iqab*) and “عُقُوبَةُ” (*ooqubah*) means punishment as a consequence {R}, but this not a rule.

The Quran has used “عُقْبَى” (*uqbah*) to mean reward for the believers, and also as a punishment for the disbelievers {R} (13:35).

Muheet says that “الْمُعَقَّبُ” (*al-muaqqibu*) also means one who makes excuses {M}.

The Quran says:

13:41	there can be no appeal against the decision of Allah (There can be no other decision after His decision)	وَاللَّهُ يَحْكُمُ لَا مُعَقَّبَ حُكْمِهِ
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“الْعَقْبَةُ” (*al-aqabatu*): a difficult road to climb on a mountain (90:11) {T}.

Ibn Faris says this word has the connotation of loftiness, harshness and difficulty.

By using words related to this root, the Quran has pointed to a very important truth. The law of requital means that there is a result for every deed. This result is either reward or punishment, dependent upon the nature of the deed. As such, reward and punishment are not external factors because they are almost inherent within the deed as if it is part of the deed itself. For example, good health is hidden in the deed of exercise. In other words, good health follows the deed of exercise.

As such, it has been said in Surah *Ar-Raad*:

13:11	Forces of Allah are at work before and behind every deed or every man, which compile the results of the deeds a man performs according to the laws of Allah	لَهُ مُعَقَّبَاتٌ مِّنْ بَيْنِ يَدَيْهِ وَمِنْ خَلْفِهِ يَحْفَظُونَهُ مِنْ أَمْرِ اللَّهِ
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This is what a result of any deed is. This is “عَاقِبَةُ” (*aqibatu*) or “عُقْبَى” (*uqba*) of every deed.

13:35	This is the result for those who obey the laws of Allah	تِلْكَ عُقْبَى الَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا
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Therefore the meaning of “عُقْبَى” (*uqba*) is not only the hereafter but it also means a result. This result manifests itself in this life as well as in hereafter.

The Quran says:

13:22	For those who obey the laws of Allah, the end result in this world is good as well.	أُولَئِكَ هُمْ عُقْبَى الدَّارِ
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The very same meaning is applied to “عَاقِبَةُ الدَّارِ” (*aaqibatud daar*) in (6:136) where the matter has been further explained by saying “فَسَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ” (*fa’saufa ta’lamoon*). This means “you will come to know about it very soon” i.e. you will find out for whom these pleasantries of life are.

“يَنْقَلِبُ عَلَى عَقْبَيْهِ” (*yanqalibu ala aaqibehi*): turn back on one’s heels. It has come against “اتِّبَاعٌ” (*itb’a*) in (2:143) i.e. following the Quran, while this means to revert to a life style which one was following earlier. For example it will mean to accept Islam and come out of ignorance, but then give up Islam and revert back to ignorance (3:143). This verse means this very thing where it is said that the system of Islam is not only till the messenger of Allah is alive, but also after him. It is said that people should not revert to the old system after his death. With this the Quran has made it clear that the Islamic system is not attached or depends on any one person or group, but moves ahead on the force of its principles. Personalities come and go but as long as the principles on which a system is established are current, the system should keep flourishing. Of course if those principles are given up then that system comes to an end. The end of messenger-hood signified that the Islamic system would no more run on the strength of any personality but that it will move ahead on the basis of its principles. Untill the Muslims follow those principles, the system will work and will come to an end only if the principles are given up. Currently we need a renaissance of this system and that can only be done by sticking strictly to the principles enshrined in the Quran.

Ain-Q-D ع ق د

“عَقْدٌ” (*aqd*): to tie a strong knot. This is the opposite of “حُلٌّ” (*hull*) which means to untie a knot.
 “عَقَدَ الْعَهْدَ” (*aqadal ahd*): he strengthened the pact {*T*}.

4:33	the people with whom you have entered into a solid pact	الَّذِينَ عَقَدْتَ أَيْمَانُكُمْ
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“الْعُقْدُ” (*al-aqd*): promise or pact {*T*}. The plural is “عُقُودٌ” (*uquud*).
 “أَوْفُوا بِالْعُقُودِ” (*auflu bil uquud*): fulfil your pacts and promises (5:1).
 “الْعُقْدَةُ” (*al-u’qdah*): knot. Plural is “عُقَدٌ” (*u’qad*).
 “عُقْدَةُ النِّكَاحِ” (*uqdatun nikah*): wedding knot (2:235).

20:77	untie the knots in my tongue (give it strength and fluency)	وَاحْلُلْ عُقْدَةً مِنْ لِسَانِي
20:78	so that the people of the pharaoh understand me	يَفْقَهُوا قَوْلِي

“عُقْدَةٌ” (*uiqdatun*): to strengthen one’s resolve, or the fidelity to the government.
 “الْتَفَقْتُ فِي الْعُقْدِ” (*an-naffasati fil uqad*): those parties or groups that try to undermine the government or reduce fidelity to it, or weaken the resolve through psychological means (113:4).
 “الْعُقْدَةُ” (*al-aqedah*): the thing that is embedded strongly in one’s mind or heart {*M*}, but the Quran has not used this word.

Ain-Q-R ع ق ر

“عَقَرَ النَّخْلَةَ” (*aqadan nakhlata*): to cut the upper part of a date palm after which it dries up {*T*}.

Raghib says it means to cut the date palm by its roots. However, both mean to cut the palm tree so that it may no longer bear fruit.

“الْعَقْرَةُ” (*al-aqra*) means for the ovary to become unable to give birth, i.e. not to be able to conceive.

“الْعَقْرُ” (*al-aqar*): to injure.

“نَاقَةٌ عَقِيرٌ” (*naqatun aqeer*): a female camel whose throat has been cut {*T*}.

The Quran uses the word “عَاقِرٌ” (*aaqir*) to mean a woman who cannot give birth (3:39, 15:9).

“عَقَرَ” (*aqar*): to kill a camel (54:29, 91:14).

“عَقْلٌ” (*aqlun*): to stop, to prevent.

“عَقَالٌ” (*iqaal*): the rope with which the lower part of a camel’s leg is tied to its calf.

“أَعْقَلَ لِسَانَهُ” (*oo-taqila lisanuhu*): his tongue stopped, he stopped talking.

“عَقَلَ” (*aqala*): he used his intellect.

“عَقَلَ الشَّيْءَ” (*aqalah shaiyee*): to understand something or deliberate upon something.

“عَقَلَ فُلَانًا” (*aqala fulana*): stopped somebody or imprisoned him.

“أَلْعَقْلَةُ” (*al-uqalah*): a thing to which someone is tied, for instance fetters etc. It also means a sanctuary because it stops a man and also because it stops an enemy from coming to that place. Hence it also means a high mountain because its height becomes an obstacle for someone from climbing it {T}.

The Quran has exhorted at many places to use one’s intellect. Those who do not use their intellect are said to be worst than animals, and they have been said to be residents of a hellish society (7:179). Those who do not accept the Quranic truths have been asked several times as to why they do not use their intellect and arrive at the truth as the Quran says. They have been asked as to why they do not deliberate upon the sayings of the Quran. They have been challenged to support their logic with proof and reasoning (27:62). In this way we see that intellect enjoys a very lofty place in the Quran; indeed, the Quran declares that it cannot be understood without the continuous use of intellect and reasoning.

“الْعَقِيلَةُ” (*al-aqelah*) among the Arabs it meant a very respectable woman who was veiled. It also meant the tribal chief, rather every rare and high profile thing {T}.

“عَقِيلَةُ النَّجْرِ” (*aqeelatil bahr*) means a pearl.

“الْعَاقُولُ” (*al-aaquul*) means a very deep part of the ocean or a sea wave. The basic matter of this word denotes being precious and being cherished.

The right thing for an intellect is to prevent one from doing the wrong thing, but if this very intellect follows emotions and desires, then it can wreak havoc (29:38). Such an individual or nation, whose intellect becomes subservient to its emotions and desires, starts to traverse the wrong way of life.

45: 23	and its resources of knowledge do not do it any good	وَأَصْلَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَى عِلْمٍ
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Also see (46:26)

Just as the senses of a man in stupor do not work properly, human intellect does not perform properly as well when a man is engulfed in emotions and desires. He then becomes slave of emotions and does whatever the emotions demand without any thought for the consequences. At this point the intellect binds man with the fetters of selfishness and prevents it from working for universal sustenance. Therefore the right thing for the intellect to do is to remain obedient to the revelation after understanding it using intellect and reasoning. In other words, if a man lets his intellect be guided by the revelation, then the intellect can be of a benefit to him (28:50).

In other words, the intellect needs the light of the revelation just like the eyes need light from the sun to be able to see clearly. This is the connection between the intellect and the revelation. Those who employ the intellect in this way are called *Momin* (65:10). The intellect which does not obey the revelation is devilish intellect or *shaaitaan* and *Iblees*. See heading (B-L-S) and (Sh-Te-N).

“عُقْمٌ” (*uqmun*): dry land which does not accept any effect.

“عَقِيمٌ” (*aqeem*): a woman who is unable to become pregnant or infertility {T}, but the usage of this word is not confined to a woman only.

“رَجُلٌ عَقِيمٌ” (*rajulun aqeeem*) and “عَقَامٌ” (*aqam*) means a man who has no children (due to infertility).

“رِيحٌ عَقِيمٌ” (*reehun aqeeem*): dry wind that does not bring any cloud with it or doesn't make rain or doesn't pollinate trees and plants {T}.

“يَوْمٌ عَقِيمٌ” (*yoomun a'qeeem*): a hard day, a day without any pleasure.

Muheet says “عُقْمٌ” (*uqam*) means to stop or prevent as well as to cut off {M}.

Ibn Faris says it that when “عَجُوزٌ عَقِيمٌ” (*ajuzan aqeeem*) has been used for the wife of Abraham in (51:29), it means an old and infertile woman. The same surah says a little further “الرَّيْحُ الْعَقِيمُ” (*ar-reehul aqeeema*) in (5:41) against “رِيحٌ لَوَافِحُ” (*riyahun lawafeeh*) (15:22), i.e. a punishment that destroys, or a calamity that destroys the ability of a particular nation to develop and thrive. It is a nation whose roots are uprooted and it remains barren.

“عَكَفَ” (*akaf*): to stop, prevent or to abstain from something.

“عَكَفَ عَلَيْهِ” (*akafa alaih*): moved continuously towards it and did not turn away.

“عَكَفَ” (*akkafa*): to make a chain of it in order to not let it go astray, or be strewn just as pearls are made into a necklace.

“عَكَفَ الْجَوْوَرُ فِي النَّظْمِ” (*akafal jaharu fin nazm*): pearls were woven into a necklace.

“شَعْرٌ مَعْكُوفٌ” (*shairun makoof*): combed or orderly hair as against hair which is a sign of disarray.

“عَكَفَ” (*akf*): to make matters orderly {T}.

Raghib says that “الْعُكُوفُ” (*al-akuf*) means to advance towards something respectfully and be attached to it permanently.

“عَكَفَ الْقَوْمُ حَوْلَهُ” (*akafal qoumu haulahu*): the nation made an orderly circle around him {T, M, R}.

The Quran says “الْهَدْيَ مَعْكُوفًا” (*al-hadya ma'kufa*) in (48:25). It means an animal that is being taken to Kaaba, probably for sacrifice, but which has been stopped along the way. Here this word means to stop.

Surah Al-Hajj says:

22:25	It has been made a sanctuary for all humanity and its doors are not closed to anybody (nor does anyone enjoy more rights here than any other place)	سَوَائِنَ الْعَاكِفُ فِيهِ وَالْبَادِ
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Surah *Taha* says “عَاكِفِينَ” (*aakifeena*) in (20:91) which means to be engaged in some work continuously, or to be committed to something.

About the *Ka'ba* it has been said in the Quran that Allah directed Ibrahim and Ismail to make it pure from “طَائِفِينَ” (*tai'feen*) and “عَاكِفِينَ” (*aa'kifeen*). That is, for the residents and travellers (2:125).

“عَاكِفِينَ” (*aakifeen*): a group or party which does not allow human beings to be separated from one another but binds them all together like pearls in a thread to keep them together. In other words, it combs the hair of humanity and keeps it orderly. Details can be found under heading (-W-F). This is the rightful status of the Muslim nation or the nation of those who have submitted their will to Allah and which has *Ka'ba* as its centre. This nation keeps itself attached to its central point and sorts out matters of humanity, and it has therefore also been called “شُهَدَاءُ عَلَى النَّاسِ” (*shuhada'a alan naas*) in (2:43) which means the observers on all of mankind. But only a group which itself is attached strongly to Allah's system as defined in the Quran and keeps it on top priority can supervise the matters of all humanity.

According to *Ibn Faris* “الْعَلَقُ” (*al-alaq*) means to attach or bind something to a lofty thing.

“الْعَلَقُ” (*al-alaq*) actually means the wooden frame around which the well’s rope goes while lowering or hauling water. It also means the entire contraption along with all necessary accoutrements.

“الْعَلَقُ” (*al-alaq*) also means blood, of whatever type. It also means leech which sucks blood. It also means the mud which sticks to one’s hands.

“الْمَعْلَقُ” (*al-me’laaq*): anything with which something is hung up, for example two ends of a well bucket which has ropes tied around the two ends.

“الْعُلَيْقُ” (*al-ullaiq*): a kind of vine which has too many thorns. If something is stuck in it, it is difficult to extricate it from itself.

“الْعَلَاقَةُ” (*al-ilaaqatu*): love that sticks to one’s heart.

“الْمُعَلَّقَةُ” (*al-u’allaqah*): a woman who cannot be described as married or divorced because of her husband being untraceable. *Azhari* says it means a woman who is neither accepted nor divorced by her husband; hence she hangs in the middle {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

4:149	so you may leave her as <i>mu-alliqaah</i>	فَتَذَرُوهَا كَالْمُعَلَّقَةِ
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The second stage of the foetus as described in Surah *Al-Momineen* is that of “عَلَقَةً” (*alaqata*) in (23:1), i.e. sole shaped or leech shaped.

Surah *Al-Alaq* says:

96:2	Man is created from <i>alaq</i>	خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ عَلَقٍ
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If “عَلَقٍ” (*alaq*) is taken to mean coagulated blood, then it will be a pointer to the physical shape of the embryo, but if the figurative meanings are taken, then it will mean that if humans are left alone without the guidance of the revelation then they find themselves overwhelmed by their desires and lust which stick to them like a leech and think only of enticing others.

As such “أَعْلَقَ الصَّاعِدُ” (*a’laqas saa’id*) means the victim found itself ensnared in the hunter’s net {T}.

Ibn Faris has said “الْعَلَقُ” (*al-alaq*) means love in which a person is ensnared.

“عِلْمٌ” (*ilmu*), “عَلِمَ” (*alima*), “يَعْلَمُ” (*yalamu*): to know about something very well, to recognize, to understand the truth, to gain conviction, to feel, to find out comprehensibly {T, M}.

“عَالِمٌ” (*aalim*): one who understands or comprehends reality. The plural is “عَالِمُونَ” (*aalimoon*).

“عَلِيمٌ” (*aleem*): one with deep and solid comprehension. The plural is “عُلَمَاءُ” (*ulema*).

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is such sign which distinguishes something from other things.

The Arabs hold “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) more sacrosanct than awareness. This is why they use this word for the knowledge of Allah and not comprehension or awareness. As such, Allah can be called “عَالِمٌ” (*aalim*) or “عَلِيمٌ” (*aleem*) but not “مَعْرِفَةٌ” (*ma’rifah*) i.e. one with understanding or one with awareness. To the Arabs there is one other difference between “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) and “مَعْرِفَةٌ” (*ma’arfah*) - “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) means knowledge while “مَعْرِفَةٌ” (*ma’arfah*) means understanding or comprehension. In order to comprehend something one has to deliberate on rules and effects, but this is not necessary for knowledge.

Secondly the word “مَعْرِفَةٌ” (*ma’arfah*) is used when a thing after comprehension is forgotten and then there is comprehension about it once again. But in “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) or knowledge, this is not the case {T}. The

example of this “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) or knowledge is that it is acquired from the revelation, and is not a product of the human intellect and reasoning (4:52).

The Quran in (2:7) has declared hearing and seeing as the elements through which knowledge is acquired. In verse (17:36) “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) has been mentioned in place of “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*). To find the difference between these two words, see heading (F-A-D) and (Q-L-B). This includes both perceptual knowledge and conceptual knowledge and with respect to “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) it also encompasses human feelings.

Since “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) can only be called so when it reaches the stage of being factual, therefore the Quran has described the revelation as “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) and its opposite has been described as “هَوَاءٌ” (*ahwa-oon*) in (2:120) which means a man’s own emotional preferences and such beliefs for which he does not have any logical reasoning or proof. This is the reason that the Quran lays a lot of emphasis on the acquisition of the knowledge about the outer world. It is because this knowledge is based on reasoning and is acquired empirically through the use of experiments. There is no room here for emotional feelings and every premise is presented on the basis of reasoning and proof (2:175). Those who oppose this knowledge are also asked to present reasoning and logic in support of their position if they can, but this they have not been able to do and cannot do (27:64).

The Quran is so assured in the truth of its message that it announces clearly and openly to present any contrary evidence to the facts stated in the revelation (23:117). As such, the invitation of the Quran towards Islam is because of the established and proven truths (12:108). These are rational and logical and not just because of some egocentric belief.

“أَلْعَلَمُ” (*al-alamu*), “أَلْعَلَامَةُ” (*al-alama*): a sign through which a thing can be recognized e.g. like a border between two agricultural fields {R}.

“عَلَامَةٌ” (*alamat*) or “عَلَمٌ” (*alama*): the signs along the road that we put up as markers.

“عَلَمٌ” (*alamu*): a large mountain. Plural is “أَعْلَامٌ” (*aalaam*) as in (55:24).

“عَلَمٌ” (*alum*): a flag, because it helps one group to recognize another.

“مُعَلَمٌ” (*mu'allam*): a sign or effect that can lead to a way.

“أَعْلَمُ” (*aalamu*): a camel whose upper lip is bisected or torn {R}.

“أَعْلَمُ الْفَرَاسِ” (*aalamul faars*): coloured wool which ancient Arabs used to tie to their horses’ necks {T}.

“أَعْلَمُ نَفْسَهُ” (*aaalama naf'sahu*): painted himself with colours which are used prior to entering a battle {M}.

From this “عَالَمٌ” (*aalam*) was culled, plural of which is “عَالَمِينَ” (*aalameen*) which we generally translate to worlds or universe.

“عَالَمٌ” (*alamun*) means “مَالِعُمٌ بِهِ” (*yulamu behi*) like “خَاتَمٌ” (*khatum*) means “مَا يُخْتَمُ بِهِ” (*khatuma behi*) or like “قَالِبٌ” (*qalib*) means “مَا يُقَلَّبُ بِهِ” (*ma yuqlibu behi*).

Thus “مَالِعُمٌ بِهِ” (*aalam behi*): a thing through which knowledge can be acquired. Since the knowledge about Allah is gained through things He has created in the universe, the universe came to be called as “عَالَمٌ” (*aalam*).

The different angles and phases of the universe came to be called “عَالَمٌ” (*aalam*) as well. For instance:

“عَالَمُ إِنْسَانٍ” (*alam-e-insaan*): “world of humans”.

“عَالَمُ مَاءٍ” (*alam-e-maa*): “world of water”

“عَالَمُ نَارٍ” (*alam-e-naar*): “world of fire”.

Whenever human beings are included with other things in the universe, they are held supreme {R}. It is for this reason that a dynasty or nation is also called “عَالَمٌ” (*aalam*) as also an era and century are called so. The Quran has used the word “عَالَمِينَ” (*aalameen*) often to mean nations. It also includes the contemporary human beings of an era.

2:4	children of Israel were given ascendancy to their contemporaries (due to their righteous conduct)	فَضَّلْنَاهُمْ عَلَى الْعَالَمِينَ
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It also means different types of people or human beings in the world (15:70).

This way “رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ” (*rabb-ul-aalameen*) in (1:1) would mean the Sustainer of international humanity in modern day language, i.e. the sustaining quality of Allah for all humans as at present and in future. It also means the Sustainer of the entire universe, in which human beings are also included. It must be understood that although the word “عَالَمٌ” (*aalam*) is used to mean the universe, the Arabs do not use this word to include stones and rocks. The Arabs use this word for particular groups where the individuals are intellectuals or close to be so.

Examples of this are:

“عَالَمُ الْإِنْسَانِ” (*aalamul insaan*): group of humans.

“عَالَمُ الْحَيَوَانَ” (*aalamul haiwaan*): group of animals

“عَالَمُ النَّبَاتِ” (*aalamun nabaat*): group of vegetation.

It is obvious that work of the Almighty’s sustenance can be observed in these groups because their members possess the ability to absorb Allah’s sustenance. This quality is most obvious in animals which possess life, receive food, reproduce, etc.

Allah’s sustenance towards entire universe, or “رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ” (*rabb-ul aalameeni*) should be manifested in a palpable manner. It should not remain a mere thought or a concept. Only this understanding of the meaning of Allah’s sustenance can evoke the emotion of praise towards Him. See heading (H-M-D).

The Quran says:

2:31	Allah bestowed the knowledge of the entire universe to Adam	عَلَّمَ آدَمَ الْأَسْمَاءَ كُلَّهَا
96:5	He taught Adam what he didn’t know before	عَلَّمَ الْإِنْسَانَ مَا لَمْ يَعْلَمْ
66:4	taught him to write with the pen	الَّذِي عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ
55:3	taught him to speak and express himself	عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

All this does not mean that Allah taught every individual like a teacher instructs his students. It means that Allah bestowed all these qualities to man, or created this ability in them.

A distinct example can be found in Surah *Al-Ma’idah* where it is said:

5:4	you teach your hunting dogs to fetch the pray, out of the knowledge that Allah has endowed on you	يَا عَلَّمَكُمُ اللَّهُ
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It is obvious that Allah does not teach human beings the ways to train hunting dogs, but He has created that ability in human beings through which they can develop their own ability to learn.

Thus a form of knowledge is that which the messengers get from Allah, i.e. the revelation, and the second form of knowledge is the capability which has been granted to all humans, and any human being can avail of it if he tries hard enough. While going through the Quran this difference between the two types of knowledge should be kept well in mind i.e. the difference between celestial guidance and that which has been ingrained in the human beings. This very difference can also be found between knowledge of a messenger and an ordinary person. A messenger receives one kind of knowledge through the revelation to which no person other than the messengers is privy, and the other type of knowledge is the human ability in which the messenger’s status is like an ordinary human being. It is this status in which messengers have been asked to consult other human beings (3:158).

Surah *Al-Faatir* says:

35:27	Have you not deliberated on the reality that Allah makes the clouds pour rain and with this same rain makes different kinds of fruits grow?	أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ أَنْزَلَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً فَأَخْرَجْنَا بِهِ ثَمَرَاتٍ
35:27	you can see different colour streaks in the mountains which are red or black (are of different types and of colour)	وَمِنَ الْجِبَالِ جُدَدٌ بَيَضٌ وَحُمْرٌ مُخْتَلِفٌ أَلْوَانُهَا

In the same way there are different kinds in humans and other living things and animals.

At such places it can be noted that the Quran has spoken about subjects that are purely scientific. After this it is said:

35:28	It is a fact that only the knowledgeable among His missionaries really take caution of Him	وَمِنَ النَّاسِ وَالْأَنْعَامِ مُخْتَلِفٌ أَلْوَانُهُ كَذَلِكَ
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This means that these are the people who really learn about His laws and then they are aware of His power and knowledge. It can be noted that the Quran has used the word “علماء” (*ulama*) in the meaning of “scientists”. The Quran lays a lot of importance on the knowledge of things. Details can be found in the book titled “*Letters to Salim*”.

Ain-L-N ع ل ن

“عَلَنَ الْأَمْرُ” (*al-anal amr*): a thing came to be known and the news travelled around.

“أَلَعَلَنَ” (*al-ilaan*) or “أَلَا عِلَانٌ” (*al-ai'laan*): to do something openly {T}.

“أَلْعَانِيَّةُ” (*al'alaniyatu*): obvious and manifest as opposite to “سِرٌّ” (*sirra*) which means secretive (2:272) {M, R}.

“أَسَرَ” (*asarra*) has come against “أَعْلَنَ” (*aa'lana*) which means to cover something up. Hence it means to talk openly about something (71:9).

Ain-L-W ع ل و

“عَدُوُّ الشَّيْءِ” (*ilwush shaiyee*): the highest part of anything as against “سِفْلٌ” (*siflun*) meaning lowest.

“أَلَعْلَاءُ” (*al-ala'oo*): honor, loftiness.

“أَعْلَاهُ” (*aa'la'hu*): great.

“عَالِي بَيْتٍ” (*a'laa bihi*), “أَسْتَعْلَاهُ” (*ista'la'hu*): climbed over something.

“أَسْتَعْلَى” (*is'taa'la*): rose high or overpowered.

“أَعْلَاهُ” (*aalahu*): raised him, or raised his status.

“تَعَالَى” (*ta'ala*): he rose (19:3).

“أَلْعَلَاوَةُ” (*al-i'lawatu*): the extra and additional weight, it is also used in a sense of extra or from a top.

“مَا عَلَوْا” (*ma'a'lau*): whatever they may overpower (17:7).

“عُلُوٌّ” (*uluwun*): revolt (17:4), but when the same word is used for Allah then it means greatness and loftiness (17:43).

“عَالِينَ” (*aaleen*): those who revolt or go against (23:46). The singular is “عَالٍ” (*aalin*) or “أَلْعَالِي” (*al-aalee*), and feminine form is “عَالِيَّةٌ” (*aaliya*).

“لَتَعْلُنَّ” (*lata'lunna*): surely you will revolt (17:2).

11:82	We turned its highest part into the lowest part	وَجَعَلْنَا عَالِيَهَا سَافِلَهَا
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“أَلْمُنْعَالُ” (*al'muta'aali*): very lofty, of high rank (13:9)

“أَلَا عَلَى” (*al'aala*): overpowering everything, the highest (87:1).

“أَلَا” (*ala*): overpowered, one over another (23:91).

“عِلْيُونُ” (*illiyuna*), “عِلْيَيْنُ” (*illiyeen*): loftiness over loftiness (83:18-19).

Kitaboona Marqoom has described that “عِلْيُونُ” (*illiyuun*) is “the record of deeds”, but such one that takes a man towards loftiness.

Against this is “سَجِيَّتٌ” (*sijjeen*) a record which stultifies the development of human beings (83:7-9).

Surah *An-Namal* says:

27:31	Do not exalt yourselves against me but come to me in submission	أَلَا تَعْلَمُونَ أَنِّي مُسْلِمٌ
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“تَعْلُوا” (*ta’lu*) means to be rebellious and “مُسْلِمِينَ” (*muslimeena*) means to become faithful and obedient.

“تَعَال” (*ta’aala*): this word is used when those in high places call on those in lower places, but due to overuse this word started being used by all to mean call {M}.

Surah *Al-Ahzaab* says:

33:28	all you women come	فَتَعَالَيْنَ
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It must be noted that the basic meaning of the root is loftiness and overpowering, but overpowering is of two types. One type is to overpower an oppressor and help the victims. This overpowering is laudable and one of the basic traits of the believers. The other type of overpowering is to oppress the weak and make them the target of one’s oppression. This sort of overpowering is despicable and an element of revolt. This sort of overpowering has been likened to revolt, because in this one’s strength is used against the directions of the Quran i.e. rebelling against Allah.

The Quran says about the believers:

3:138	do not be dishearten, you will overpower them at last, because you have faith in Allah’s laws	وَلَا يَجْنُؤُوا وَلَا يَحْزَنُوا وَاَنْتُمْ الْاَعْلَوْنَ اِنْ كُنْتُمْ مُؤْمِنِينَ
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Here we have reference to the overpowering which conquers false concepts and strengths, and then sets up a just system based on egalitarianism. A believer can never remain overpowered by the deniers.

4:141	Allah will never let the unbelievers overpower the believers	وَلَنْ يَجْعَلَ اللَّهُ لِلْكَافِرِينَ عَلَى الْمُؤْمِنِينَ سَبِيلًا
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It is possible that the believers may suffer a temporary setback (3:139) but it is impossible for the unbelievers to remain in an overpowering situation over the believers for long. As such, if those who call themselves believers or *momineen* remain under the domination of unbelievers for long, whether this domination is of power, money or economic, then they should understand that according to the Quranic definition they do not qualify as *momineen*.

A’laa عَلَى

This letter is used in many ways.

1) It means “on” or “over”, whether literally or figuratively:

23:22	you all mount on the ark	عَلَى الْفُلْكِ تُحْمَلُونَ
2:253	We have given you superiority over others	فَضَّلْنَا بَعْضَهُمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ

2) In the meaning of “near”:

20:10	or if I see a leader near that fire	أَوْ أَجِدُ عَلَى النَّارِ هُدًى
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3) In the meaning of “despite”:

2:177	when they give money to others (through charity), despite their great love towards their wealth	وَآتَى الْمَالَ عَلَى حُبِّهِ
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4) In the meaning of “from” or “of”:

83:2	when they take from people after due measurement	إِذَا أَكْتَالُوا عَلَى النَّاسِ
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5) In the meaning of “because of”:

2:185	You hold the system of Allah supreme because He has given you guidance. (Because of guidance of the Sustainer you should highlight the system of Allah.)	لِتُكَبِّرُوا اللَّهَ عَلَىٰ مَا هَدَاكُمْ
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6) In the meaning of “in”:

28:15	he got in to the city when its residents were unaware	وَدَخَلَ الْمَدِينَةَ عَلَىٰ حِينٍ غَفْلَةٍ مِّنْ أَهْلِهَا
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7) In the meaning of “with” or “about”:

7:105	it is incumbent upon me that I do not say anything about Allah that is not true	حَقِيقٌ عَلَىٰ أَن لَا أَقُولَ عَلَىٰ اللَّهِ إِلَّا الْحَقَّ
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Here “عَلَىٰ أَن لَا أَقُولَ” (*ala an alla aqul*) means “بِأَن لَا أَقُولَ” (*bi'al la aqul*) i.e. “I should not speak anything but the truth”.

8) In the meaning of “up to”:

16:9	the moderate or straight path that reaches up to Allah	وَعَلَىٰ اللَّهِ قَصْدُ السَّبِيلِ
15:41	this straight path reaches up to Me.	هَذَا صِرَاطٌ عَلَىٰ مُّسْتَقِيمٍ

9) In the meaning of “in front” or “face to face”:

30:39	so that you are trained or brought up before my eyes (in front of me)	وَلِيُصْنَعَ عَلَىٰ عَيْنِي
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10) In the meaning of “against”:

20:61	at least you should not speak untruth about Allah	لَا تَقْتَرُوا عَلَى اللَّهِ كَذِبًا
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11) In the meaning of “according to” or “similar to”:

6:136	work according to your strength or work in your own sphere	اعْمَلُوا عَلَىٰ مَكَانَتِكُمْ
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12) Sometime the word is additional and does not mean anything.

13) In the meaning of “through” or “via”:

3:193	O Lord, grant us whatever you have promised us through the messengers	رَبَّنَا وَإِنَّا مَا وَعَدْتَنَا عَلَىٰ رُسُلِكَ
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14) In the meaning of “against”. The Quran speaks of the rights and responsibilities of women:

2:228	Whatever are their responsibilities, so are their rights	وَلَهُنَّ مِثْلُ الَّذِي عَلَيْنَهُنَّ
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The letter “ل” (*laam*) is used to denote some benefit in the Arabic language. Against it “عَلَى” (*ala*) is used.

15) In the meaning of “upon” as a sense of duty:

	the truth is incumbent upon you (you must speak the truth)	عَلَيْكُمْ بِالصِّدْقِ
5:105	the reform of your personae is incumbent upon you (you must always try to reform yourself)	عَلَيْكُمْ أَنْفُسُكُمْ

See heading “عَنْ” (*an*) and “ما” (*maa*).

Ibn Faris says this root basically means solidity and straightness whether it is in things that can be felt or in opinion and intent.

“الْعُمُودُ” (*al-umud*) means the central wooden stake in a tent which supports the tent. Its plural forms are “أَعْمِدَةٌ” (*aamidatun*), “عَمْدٌ” (*umadun*) or “عُمْدٌ” (*umudun*). “الْعَمَدُ” (*al-amad*) also means the columns of marble {*T*}.

The Quran says:

13:2	Allah has arranged planets in space with support of invisible columns	رَفَعَ السَّمُوتِ بِعَمَلٍ تَرَوْنَهَا
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The columns which support the planets are of mutual gravity that cannot be seen with the naked eye. “اَمَادَانِ” (*amadan*) is plural of “عُمُودٌ” (*umuud*) or “عِمَادٌ” (*imaad*).

Surah *Al-Hamza* says:

104:9	in long columns	فِي عَمَلٍ مُّمدَّدَةٍ
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“الْعُمُودُ” (*al-umud*): tribal chief who can be depended upon in different matters. It may also be used for the head of the army.

“طَوِيلُ الْعِمَادِ” (*taweelul i'maad*): a tall and hefty man.

“عِمَادٌ” (*i'maad*): also means long and length.

Regarding the nation of *Aad*, the Quran says:

89:7	They were possessors of <i>i'maad</i>	إِزَمَ ذَاتِ الْعِمَادِ
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There are different meanings to this:

“الْعِمَادُ” (*al-i'maad*): a tall building. Its singular is “عِمَادَةٌ” (*i'madah*). This way it would mean the nation which was the owner or possessor of big and tall buildings.

“عِمَادٌ” (*i'maddun*) also means tents. Going by this the sentence would mean “people who stayed in tents” {*T*}, or “people who were very tall” {*T*}.

Raghib says “الْعِمَادُ” (*al-i'maad*) means a thing which is leaned against and depended upon.

As such, “ذَاتِ الْعِمَادِ” (*zaatil i'maad*) would mean the possessor of those things on which they relied upon {*R*}.

“الْعُمْدَةُ” (*al-umdatuh*): something that can be relied or depended upon {*M*}.

“الْعَمْدُ” (*al-amd*) or “الْعَمْدُ” (*at-ta'ammud*): the work that is undertaken with a purpose and intent. This has been used against “” (*khata-un*) in (3:92-93) and (33:5).

For the meaning of “قتل عمد” (*qatali umad*) and “قتل خطأ” (*qatali khata*), see heading (Q-T-L).

“الْعِمَارَةُ” (*al-imaratu*), is the opposite of “خَرَابٌ” (*kharab*) which mean to make desolate and destroy. As such, “عِمَارَةٌ” (*imaratun*) would mean to habitat.

“الْعُمُرُ” (*al-umur*): the time or period during which a body and soul stay together {*M*}.

“عَمَّرَهُ اللَّهُ” (*ammarhul laah*): Allah extended his life span {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says this root has two meanings:

- 1) Lasting and extension of time
- 2) Something that can be raised or extended, whether it is a voice or something else.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:9	may he be allowed to live a thousand years	لَوْ يُعَمَّرُ أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ
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“أَعْمَرَ الْأَرْضَ” (*aa'maral arz*): found the land inhabited.

“الْعِمَارَةُ” (*al-imaratu*): that which is needed for inhabiting a land.

“الْعُمْرَةُ” (*al-umratu*): to go to an inhabited place. It also means to perform *Hajj* or go around the *Ka'ba*.

“إِعْتَمَرَ” (*i'tamara*): to perform pilgrimage *Umra* (2:158).

“تَعْمِيرُ النَّوْبِ” (*ta'meerut tawb*): to weave a fine cloth.

“الْعَمْرُ” (*al-amru*): way of life.

The Quran says:

15:72	your way of life is testimony to this truth	لَعَمْرُكَ إِنَّهُمْ لَفِي سَكْرَتِهِمْ يَعْمَهُونَ
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Usually the Arabs use “لَعَمْرُكَ” (*la-amruka*) when they swear by life and existence of somebody.

The Quran says:

9:17	it is not the work of those who attribute partners to Allah to inhabit the mosques of Allah	مَا كَانَ لِلْمُشْرِكِينَ أَنْ يَعْمُرُوا مَسَاجِدَ اللَّهِ
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The mosque is the center of a system which is entirely based upon the Quranic values. Those who include man-made laws along with these laws can't be the inhabitants of these mosques. That is why the Quran has called the mosque that was built to create differences within the believers as a fuel of hell (9:106-107). Sectarianism too is a form of attributing man-made laws to Allah (30:32).

Surah *At-Toor* says:

52:4	an inhabited home	وَالْبَيْتِ الْمَعْمُورِ
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Hence it means a place to be kept inhabited, or a place which will always remain inhabited, or will never become desolate or deserted. This has been said for the building of *Ka'ba*.

The Quran has mentioned the progeny of *Imran* or “آل عمران” (*aal imran*) in (3:32). It is said that *Imran* was the name of messenger *Moosa*'s father. Therefore “آل عمران” (*aal imran*) means the children of Israel.

“إِمْرَأَتُ إِمْرَانَ” (*imra'a'tu Imran*) in (3:34) means the woman or wife of *Imran*.

“إِبْنَتُ إِمْرَانَ” (*ibnatu Imran*): a girl of the descendants, or daughter of *Imran* (66:12), i.e. *Mariam*, mother of *Isa* (Jesus).

“الْعُمُقُ” (*al-amq*), “الْعُمُقُ” (*al-umuq*) or “الْعُمُقُ” (*al-umuq*): all mean the depth of a well etc.

Raghib says that “عَمَقَ” (*amqun*) actually means the distance downwards or depth.

Ibnul Araabi says with reference to *Ibn Faris* that “عُمُقُ” (*umq*) means the depth or length of a road, or the depth and width of a well.

The Quran says:

22:27	from every distance	مِنْ كُلِّ فَجٍّ عَمِيقٍ
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Muheet says that “الْعُمُقُ” (*al-umq*) and “الْعَمَاقَةُ” (*al-amaqah*) both mean to be long, to be at a distance and to be spreading, as well as being deep {M}.

“عَمَلٌ” (*amal*): work, skill, expertise and work with cleverness. Some linguists think that word “عَمَلٌ” (*amal*) is more intense or particular than ‘deed’.

This is because the word “عَمَلٌ” (*amal*) is used to mean a continuous struggle and that is why the word is not used for Allah, but rather “فَعَلٌ” (*fa’ala*). The difference between “فَعَلٌ” (*fa’ala*) and “عَمَلٌ” (*amila*) has been made clear under heading (F-Ain-L).

Raghib says that it means any act committed with intent by a living being.

As against the word “عَمَلٌ” (*amila*) which can be used for animals even if they have committed the act without intent, and even by plants. But the word “عَمَلٌ” (*am’al*) is seldom used for them {T}.

Muheet has said that some linguists and the author of dictionaries think that “عَمَلٌ” (*amal*) is a comprehensive form of “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) or knowledge. As under heading (F-Ain-L) it has been said that for “عَمَلٌ” (*amal*) to be used for “عِلْمٌ” (*ilm*) or knowledge is a necessary condition {M}.

“عَمَلٌ” (*amala*): work that has not been undertaken only in the spur of a moment but is always done in a particular way.

“عَامِلٌ” (*aamil*): one who does a work or commits an act. The plurals are “عَامِلُونَ” (*aamiloon*) and “عَامِلِينَ” (*aamileen*).

9:60	those who collect tax	وَالْعَامِلِينَ عَلَيْهَا
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The Quran speaks about the result of deeds or “أَعْمَالٌ” (*amaal*) i.e. for the deeds that a man does with a purpose and intent.

16:97	Any man or woman, who performs righteous deeds, is definitely given a goodly live and they shall be amply rewarded for the good work that they have been doing.	مَنْ عَمِلَ صَالِحًا مِنْ ذَكَرٍ أَوْ أَنْثَىٰ وَهُوَ مُؤْمِنٌ فَلَنُحْيِيَنَّهُ حَيٰوةً طَيِّبَةً وَلَنَجْزِيَنَّهُمْ أَجْرَهُمْ بِأَحْسَنِ مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ
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The focal point of the Quran teachings is developing conviction and doing righteous deeds. This means to accept the permanent values and then believing and acting within these values knowing that these will result in the desired results as noted in the Quran– this is called Islam. It is important to continue doing it with persistence and full intent – this is what this root means i.e. keep doing it because this will always result into postive results.

“أَلْعَمَّ” (*al-amma*): brother of the father i.e. uncle.

The plurals are “أَعْمَامٌ” (*aamaam*), “عُمُومَةٌ” (*umumah*) and “أُؤُمَمٌ” (*a'oomma*).

“أَلْعَمَّةُ” (*al-ammatu*): sister of the father i.e. aunt. Its plural is “عَمَّاتٌ” (*ammaat*).

Raghib says the word has actually been culled from “عُمُومٌ” (*umum*) which means to be included.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are many such as length or tallness and height.

“أَلْعَمِيمُ” (*al-ameem*): a tall plant.

“عَمَّةٌ” (*ammat*): a tall date tree.

“عَمَّ الشَّيْءُ عُمُومًا” (*ammash shhaiyee umuma*): the thing became common, i.e. all the people were included in it.

“أَلْعَامَّةُ” (*al-aamma*): ordinary people.

“أَلْعِمَامَةُ” (*al-imamatu*): anything that is worn or tied around the head {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

4:23	father's sisters (has been forbidden to wed)	عَمَّتُكُمْ
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“عَمَّةٌ” (*amatah*): to roam hither and thither in surprise or consternation after losing the way but not knowing which road or path is the right one.

“أَرْضٌ عَمْبَاءٌ” (*arzun amha-u*): the land which does not possess any milestones or directions.

“ذَهَبَتْ إِلَيْهِ الْعُمَمَى” (*zahabat ibiluhul ummaha*) is said when somebody loses his camels without any trace {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are surprise and wonderment at having very little clue as to the right direction or path. In other words it means that a man is at a loss to understand what he should or should not do, and because of this he is confused and worried.

Lataif-ul-Lugha therefore says that the blindness of insight is called “عَمَّةٌ” (*amah*) and blindness of eyesight is called “عَمَى” (*am'a*).

Raghib and *Zamakhshari* say “عَمَى” (*am'a*) can be used for the blindness of insight as well as eyesight

The Quran says:

24:61	blindness of eyesight	لَيْسَ عَلَى الْأَعْمَى حَرْجٌ
2:18	Deaf, dumb and blind of insight	صُمٌّ بُكْمٌ عُمْىٌ

“عَمَهُ فُلَانٌ” (*amiha fulan*) is said when a person seems at a loss to present proof or valid argument or reasoning and therefore he seems bamboozled or surprised at this {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:15	After loosing direction are bewildered	فِي طُعْيَانِهِمْ يَعْمَهُونَ
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It denotes the condition of consternation after having lost the way and to be worried on that account.

Surah *Al-Muminoon* says that these people are:

23:74	Those who have moved away from the right path	عَنِ الصِّرَاطِ لَنَّاكِلُونَ
23:75	Bewildered after loosing direction	فِي طُعْيَانِهِمْ يَعْمَهُونَ

This makes the meaning of “عَمَّ” (*amahun*) clear i.e. to be worried because one has moved away or lost the way to the right path.

Ain-M-Y ع م ي

“عَمِيَ” (*amiya*), “يَعْمَى” (*ya'myaa*), “عَمَى” (*a'mya*): to be blind in both eyes. If a person is blind in one eye only, he cannot be called “أَعْمَى” (*aama*).

Lataif-ul-Lugha says the loss of insight is called “عَمَه” (*a'mah*) and the loss of eyesight is called “عَمَى” (*amya*).

“الْعَمَى” (*al-ama*): loss of insight. See heading (Ain-M-He).

“عَمِيَّةٌ” (*amiyyatun*): to become wayward or lose the way, to become adamant on falsehood.

“أَلَا عُمَاءُ” (*al-aama'o*): desolate lands with no sign of habitation.

“أَلَا عُمَيَّانَ” (*al-aamayaan*): destruction wreaked by fire and flood. When these two calamities come they do not see if the good are caught up in their devastation or the bad. They take their course unseeingly or blindly without consideration for anyone.

“الْعَامِي” (*al-aami*): a person who cannot find the way {*T*}.

“عَمِيَ عَلَيْهِ الْأَمْرُ” (*amiya alihil amr*): so and so matter became unclear and doubtful for him {*M*}.

“الْعَمَايَةُ” (*al-amayatu*): waywardness, doggedness and waywardness. It also means the last part of a dark night {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says this root basically means to cover or hide.

Lissan-ul-Arab says “قَوْمٌ عُمُونَ” (*qoumun amoon*) is a nation that is unable to assess the situation correctly or becomes unable to do so.

The Quran says:

17:72	the man who is blind in this world shall also be blind in the hereafter	وَمَنْ كَانَ فِي هَذِهِ أَعْمَىٰ فَهُوَ فِي الْآخِرَةِ أَعْمَىٰ وَأَضَلُّ سَبِيلًا
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Fara says the meaning of this verse is that a person or a nation which is devoid of bliss in this world shall be devoid of any bliss in the hereafter as well, i.e. he/nation will be so wayward that they will move very far away from the right path.

The truth is that in this verse “وَأَضَلُّ سَبِيلًا” (*wa azallu sabeela*) has made the meaning of “أَعْمَى” (*aama*) clear. It is used for a person who loses the right path and goes far away and becomes a victim to hunger, thirst, deprivation and poor conditions, and in fact cannot enjoy the blessings of life in this world. Such a person can find no landmark to salvation.

This has been explained by the Quran at another place where it has said:

20:124	whoever moves away from the Divine Laws will be deprived of the economic benefits (in this world) and We shall raise him blind on the Day of judgment	وَمَنْ أَعْرَضَ عَنْ دِينِي فَإِنَّ لَهُ مَعِيشَةً ضَنْكًا وَنَحْشُرُهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ أَعْمَىٰ
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As such, by leaving aside the laws of Allah we meet deprivation and humiliation in this world, and anyone whose life is so miserable in this world will have a bad hereafter as well (as two are linked as detailed in the Quran).

The Quran says: “صُمُّ بُكْمٌ عُمَىٰ” (*soomun bookmun umyun*) in (2:18). “عُمَيَّانَا” (*umyana*) here means blind. “أَعْمَى” (*aama*) and “عُمَيَّانَ” (*umyanoon*) are the plurals of “عُمَى” (*umyun*).

Surah **Taha** uses the word “بَصِيرٌ” (*basir*) opposite to “أَعْمَى” (*aama*) in (20:125).

Surah **Al-Anaam** has said that whoever lives according to the light of the Divine Message is “بَصِيرٌ” (*basir*). This means that anyone who does not live by the message is “أَعْمَى” (*aama*) (6:50).

Surah **Ha-Meem-Sijdah** uses “الْعَمَى” (*al-ama*) against “الْهَدَى” (*al-huda*) in (41:17). Here the meaning of “أَعْمَى” (*al-ama*) is to lose the right way.

Verse (27:81) says that disrespect is blindness. In verse (13:16) it is said that anyone who does not believe in the truths of the Quran is blind or “أَعْمَى” (*aama*).

Surah **Al-Qasas** says:

28:66	matters have become doubtful on them	فَعَمِيَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ الْأَنْبَاءُ
11:28	such distinct reasoning is not seen by you	فَعَمِيَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ

Surah **Al-Hajj** describes similar condition as having the eyes of the heart or mind blinded:

22:46	To see the truth in front of one's eyes and still not to see the facts clearly.	تَعْمَى الْقُلُوبُ الَّتِي فِي الصُّدُورِ
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As such, just as our eyes need sunlight to see things clearly, so does our intellect need light of the revelation. In other words, if there is no sunlight then the eyes become blind and cannot see, and same way does intellect if there is no light of the revelation.

The same is applicable at a group level I.e, when nations which remain blind by not living according to the light of the revelation are denuded of the blessings of this life. A nation whose present is dark ultimately has similar future in store i.e. what we sow so shall we reap. It is not necessary that a nation which has a very ‘bright’ present also shall have a future that will be equally pleasant or bright. However, it is a must that a nation which can lay claim to a bright future can only have it through a bright present. This is because a nation which goes by the laws of Allah and enjoys the blessings in this world can also do good deeds in this world which can ensure a bright future in the hereafter as well. The Quran says that the **malaikah** or the instruments of Allah were made to bow before **Adam**. Thus the status of **momin** is that all the forces in nature are subservient to him and man can employ them for his benefit and for the benefit of all humanity, if he makes effort. Contrary to this the nation or the individual who cannot master the elements of nature cannot even reach the status of a human being, leave alone the status of a **momin**. But the individual or nation which can attain the status of a man but not a **momin** will have a blissful life in this world, but not have anything in the hereafter. The life of this world and of the hereafter both can be blissful for a righteous believer who master the forces of nature and live a life according to the revelation.

Un عَنْ

The term “عَنْ” (*un*) is used in a lot of meanings, for instance:

1)

24:63	they oppose His orders	يُخَالِفُونَ عَنْ أَمْرِهِ
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2) To go from one place to another, to transfer, to move away:

23:47	they are ones to move away from this path	عَنِ الصِّرَاطِ لَنَا كِبُورٌ
11:74	fear left Ibrahim and went away	ذَهَبَ عَنْ إِبْرَاهِيمَ الرَّوْعُ وَإِبْرَاهِيمُ
	I travelled away from the city and went far away from there	سَافَرْتُ عَنْ الْبَلَدِ

3) In the meaning of “in return” or “from”:

2:48	on that day no person shall make any concession or be able to atone on behalf of another person	يَوْمًا لَا تَجْزِي نَفْسٌ عَنْ نَفْسٍ شَيْئًا
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4) In the meaning of “because” or “due to” as in:

11:53	we are not going to stop worshipping our idols just because you ask us to	وَمَا نَحْنُ بِتَارِكِي آلِهَتِنَا عَنْ قَوْلِكَ
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5) In the meaning of “up” or “later”:

84:19	you will go upwards from one state to another or you will pass onto another state after being in one state	لَتَرْكَبُنَّ طَبَقًا عَنِّي طَبَقِي
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6) In the meaning of “from”:

42:45	And it is He Who accepts repentance from his servants .	هُوَ الَّذِي يَقْبَلُ التَّوْبَةَ عَنْ عِبَادِهِ
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7) In the meaning of “through”:

53:3	he does not include anything (in the Quran) from his own desires	مَا يَنْطَلِقُ عَنِ الْهَوَى
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This means that whatever the messenger says in the Quran is not his own thoughts but the saying of Allah which is transmitted to him through the revelation.

8) In the meaning of “with”, “through” or “via”, or “with the help of”:

	threw or shot the arrow with the help of the bow	رَمَيْتُ عَنِ الْقَوْسِ يَعْنِي رَمَيْتُ بِالْقَوْسِ
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9) It is also used in the meaning of “in”.

10) It is sometime additional or redundant in a sentence. The dictionary has the examples of the above two cases.

Ain-N-B ع ن ب

“الْعَنْبُ” (*al-inb*) the singular of which is “عَنْبَةً” (*inabatah*) means grapes. It is also used to mean the grape vine as well as the fruit itself {*T, R*}. “أَعْنَابٌ” (*a’naab*) is the plural of “عَنْبٌ” (*inab*). “الْعَنْبُ” (*al-inb*): wine made from grapes.

Ain-N-T ع ن ت

“الْعُنُوتُ” (*al-anoot*): a hill which is difficult to climb.

Ibn Faris says that there is the sense of struggle, demolition and pain in the basic meaning of this root, and has no connotation of comfort and rightness or correctness in it. As such, it also has the connotation of weakness and difficulty and hard work.

“عَنِتَّ الْعَظْمُ” (*anital azm*): the bone became weak and broke.

“عَنِتَّ يَدُهُ” (*anitat yadhu*): his hand broke.

“عَنْتَهُ” (*anatahu*): put him into a difficulty or delegated some work to him which was difficult {*T*}.

Ibnul Arabi says “إِعْنَاتٌ” (*inat*) means to burden a man with more work than he can handle.

The author of *Mafardaat* says that “مَعَانَتُهُ” (*ma’aanatahun*) almost means the same as “مُعَانَدَةٌ” (*mu’anadatun*) which means continuous struggle and enmity but “مَعَانَتُهُ” (*ma’anatun*) is more comprehensive because it also holds the element of fear and killing. As such, “عَنْتَ فُلَانٌ” (*anta fulanun*) is said when a man gets entangled in affairs which have the chance of killing or devastation {*R*}.

The Quran says:

49:7	you would be in difficulty or devastation	لَعْنَتُمْ
3:117	they really want you to face misery or be annihilated or destroyed	وَدُّوا مَا عَنِتُّمْ

About sexual relations it has been said in Surah *An-Nisa*:

4:25	these are orders for stopping one from stepping into a destructive state	ذَٰلِكَ لِمَنْ خَشِيَ الْعَنَتَ
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“عَنْتٌ” (*anatan*) is a comprehensive word which imparts the sense of chaos, sin, annihilation or destruction, error, slip up, cruelty, oppressiveness, excess, hard labor and facing difficulty {T}.

Ain-N-D ع ن د

“عَنْدٌ” (*anad*), “عِنْدٌ” (*inad*), “عُنْدٌ” (*unad*), “عُنُودًا” (*unuda*), “عَنِ الطَّرِيقِ” (*anit tareeq*): he moved away from the path, moved aside, got separated, or went back on.

Ibn Faris says this root holds meaning of exceeding limit and of losing right path.

“عَنْدَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*anadatin naaqa*): she-camel separated herself from the other camels and grazed by herself.
 “عِنْدَ الرَّجُلِ” (*anadar rajul*): the man rebelled and knowingly rejected that which was the truth and opposed it.

“عَنِيدٌ” (*anidun*): such a man that rebels and knowingly rejects or opposes the truth.
 “الْعَانِدُ” (*al-aanidu*): the camel which leaves or moves away from the path.
 “الْمُعَانِدَةُ” (*al-mu'aanadahu*), “الْعِنَادُ” (*inaad*): to be separated, to leave, oppose continuously.
 “عِنْدَ الرَّجُلِ عَنْ أَصْحَابِهِ” (*anadir rajulu un as'habhi*): he changed his path during the journey and left his friends, or was left behind by his friends.
 “عَانِدَةُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*aanidaatut tareeq*): the way which is removed to one side or away from the right path.
 “الْعِنْدُ” (*al-anadu*): to obstruct, to come in between {T}.

The Quran says:

74:16	he was rebellious towards Our laws	إِنَّهُ كَانَ لِأَيَّتِنَا عَيْنِدَا
14:15	every oppressor and rebel was annihilated or destroyed	وَحَاطَ كُلُّ جُنَّارٍ عَيْنِدٍ

Inda عِنْدَ

“عِنْدٌ” (*inda*) is a pronoun and means near.

43:85	the knowledge about the ‘moment’ is with Allah	عِنْدَهُ عِلْمُ السَّاعَةِ
4:78	From Allah’s side	مِنْ عِنْدِ اللَّهِ
58.6	tell them that which you are in such a hurry to witness is not with me	قُلْ لَوْ أَنِّي عِنْدِي مَا تَسْتَعْجِلُونَ بِهِ

Ain-N-Q ع ن ق

Ibn Faris says that this root basically means to sell, whether it is on a height or on land.

“الْعُنُقُ” (*al-unuqu*), the plural of which is “أَعْنَاقُ” (*aa'naaq*) means neck.
 “فَاضْرِبُوا فَوْقَ الْأَعْنَاقِ” (*fazribu fauqal aa'naaq*): hit them on the neck i.e. the head (8:12). It also means a big group or party.
 “الْأَعْنَاقُ” (*al-aanaqu*): those who remain in front. It also means the bigwigs of the nation {T}.

26:4	the bigwigs of their nation shall become humble and bow before you (submit to you)	فَطَلَّتْ أَعْنَافُهُمْ لَهَا خَاضِعِينَ
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“الْعَنْكَبُوتُ” (*al-ankabuut*): spider.

The Quran has likened the attitude and machinations of those who attribute partners to Allah as the web of a spider (29:41) which can be demolished easily by the finger or some straw i.e. it is so flimsy. The beliefs of these people are based on superstition and unawareness and therefore the intellect and reasoning based on rational thinking can expose them easily.

‘*Shirk*’ means to think that there are more than one powers or personalities which are working within this universe and that there are more than one law designed by these powers which are at work. But the truth is that the laws made by the one and only Allah is at work in the entire universe. As such, it follows necessarily that in the world of humans too, only one law made by Allah should be at work. In any case if there were more than one law at work, then necessarily they would clash with each other very often. To accept only one Allah and only His laws means belief in the oneness of Allah. This is a very concrete concept of life. As against this, every other concept is nothing but a flimsy thing just as a spider’s web.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meanings of this root word are

- 1) To wish for something very intensely
- 2) Humbleness
- 3) For something to come out in the open or become manifest.

Regarding humbleness “الْعَنُوءُ” (*al-unwu*) or “الْعَنَاءُ” (*al-ana’o*) means to be imprisoned, or to become faithful or obedient.

“الْعَنُوءَةُ” (*al-anwatu*): extreme anger or forcible.

Taj-ul-Uroos says “عَنْوَةٌ” (*anwatun*) means to take something forcibly, but *Ibn Saida* has said that it also means love. Thus this word seems to have two opposite meanings i.e. anger and forcible but at the same time it means obedient and faithful {*T*}.

Muheet says that “عَنَا الشَّيْءُ” (*anish shaiyun*) means that he made the thing manifest {*M*}.

“عَنْتِ الْأَرْضُ بِالنبَاتِ تَعْنُو” (*anatil arzu bin nabaati ta’nu*): the land or soil made plants manifest {*T*}.

The Quran says:

20:111	the people will stand up to establish the system of Allah and work voluntarily for its success with all their heart	وَعَنْتِ الْوُجُوهُ لِلْحَيِّ الْقَيُّومِ
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Some people have translated it to mean “to bow or submit” but others have translated it to mean “to stand up and work” or “struggle”. This meaning encompasses the overwhelming-ness of the laws of Allah and the obedience of those who submit to Him. It can be said with reference to being manifest, that the hidden talents of these people will also become manifest in this process.

“عَبَدَ الشَّيْءَ” (*ahidash shaiy'o*): to protect and look after something continuously, to oversee it permanently. Going by these meanings of “عَهْدٌ” (*ahdun*), the word also started being used for that firm pact where overseeing of which is necessary {*M*}.

When this word is followed by “إِلَى” (*ila*) then it means “an order” {*T*} like:

2:145	We ordered Ibrahim	عَهْدْنَا إِلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ
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Ibn Faris says if “إِلَى” (*ila*) is used after this word then it means that one is advised or counselled to protect a thing which he has been entrusted with.

Raghib says it means to make someone vow to something and make him liable to protect it.

“عَهْدٌ” (*ahdun*): responsibility and sanctuary {*T*}.

2:142	We cannot fulfill this responsibility for one who becomes rebellious of Our laws	لَا يَتَأَلَّ عَهْدِي الظَّالِمِينَ
2:41	fulfill the promise that you have made to Me and I will fulfill the responsibilities that I have undertaken on your behalf	أَوْفُوا بِعَهْدِي أُوفِ بِعَهْدِكُمْ
7:102	We have found many of them to be not faithful to their promise.	وَمَا وَجَدْنَا لِأَكْثَرِهِمْ مِنْ عَهْدٍ

“عَهْدٌ” (*ahdun*): fidelity {*T*}.

“عَهْدَةٌ” (*uhdatun*): responsibility {*T*}.

“عَهْدٌ” (*ahd*): declarations of kings and rulers.

“عَهْدٌ” (*ahd*): familiarity or meeting.

“عَبَدَ الشَّيْءَ” (*ahidash shaiyee*): recognized a thing {*T*}.

“الْعَيْنُ” (*al-ihnu*): colored wool, wool colored in different colors.

“الْعَيْنَةُ” (*al-uhnatu*): breaking of a tree branch, or to break without being separated from the tree.

“الْعَايُنُ” (*al-aahinu*): a pauper, one whose limbs are loose {*T, R*}.

“قَضِيبٌ عَائِنٌ” (*qazibun aaheenoon*): a piece of wood which is bent and weak.

Ibn Faris says it basically means softness and facility.

The Quran says:

70:9	the mountains will become like multicoloured wool	وَتَكُونُ الْجِبَالُ كَالْعَيْنِ
101:5	coloured wool which has been thrashed	الْعَيْنِ الْمَنْقُوشِ

This means coloured wool that has been taken apart. Hence verse (70:9) is pointing towards a terrible broken down condition of mountains.

“عَوَجٌ” (*awija*) or “يَعْوَجُ” (*ya'waju*) means to be crooked.
 “الْعَوَجُ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*al-ewaju fil arz*): for the ground to be uneven.
 “عَاجَ عَنْهُ” (*aaaja unhu*): returned from him, returned, abstained {*T*}.
 “مَا أَعُوْجُ بِكَلَامِهِ” (*ma'aaooj bi kalmihi*): I am not enamored with what he says;
 “إِنْعَاجَ عَلَيْهِ” (*al-aaaja aliaihi*): he turned towards him {*M*}.

Raghib says:

“الْعَوَجُ” (*al-awaju*) means the crookedness which can be seen by the naked eye, like the inequities in society and the crookedness of life.
 “الْعَوَاجُ” (*al-iwaju*): crookedness which can be understood through insight and comprehension, like the inequities of the society and the lopsidedness of life in general {*R*}.

Ibn Faris says:

“الْعَوَجُ” (*al-awaju*) means the crookedness in a straight thing like a wall or a piece of wood.
 “الْعَوَاجُ” (*al-ewaju*): crookedness that is present in a hidden thing like some matter or affair.

Surah **Al-Kaif** says about the Quran:

18:1	this is a code of life which has no crookedness (no ambiguity, simple and clear to understand)	وَمَا يَجْعَلُ لَهُ عِوَجًا
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Against it has come “قَيِّمًا” (*qayiman*) in (18:2) which means stability. About its opponents it has been said:

7:45	they want that this straight path may develop unevenness and complexities	يَبْعُثُونَهَا عِوَجًا
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Quran says that when the revolution of the Quran comes, all crookedness and inequities of the bigwigs shall be smoothed out. They will lose all their vigor and pomp (20:105-107). At this time they will follow the man in whose invitation there is no crookedness (20:108).

There are no turns and twists in the right path to which the Quran points. It is straight forward, but the vested interests want to create complexities in it for no apparent reason -their own desires and interests prevent them to come to the Quran (28:50).

“الْعَوْدُ” (*al-audu*): returned. Some say that “الْعَوْدُ” (*al-aud*) means to restart some work all over again i.e. from the beginning.

Raghib and **Zamikhshri** say that “ابتداء” (*ibtidaa*) is also used to mean to do something for the first time.

Muheet has supported this contention, and as proof presented the statement of the messenger **Shoaib** in which he told the opponents:

7:89	If we agree to accept your way of life then it would mean that we are making false allegations against Allah	قَدْ افْتَرَيْنَا عَلَى اللَّهِ كَذِبًا إِنَّ عُدْنَا فِي مِلَّتِكُمْ
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Here “عُدْنَا” (*udna*) does not mean to go back to their religion because **Shoaib** was never one of their religion in the first place. As such, it means that “we will never accept your religion” {*T, M*}, but this verse has another aspect as well which must be noted. The plural pronoun has been used in this sentence which shows clearly that the answer is from the tribe of **Shoaib** and the messenger **Shoaib** is not included in it although the answer is purportedly in his words. This means that this answer is expressing the views of his group. If this meaning is taken then “عُدْنَا” (*udna*) would mean to return because **Shoaib's** companions used to harbor the beliefs of these opponents previously.

The author of *Taj-ul-Uroos* says that “عاد” (*aad*) means to return but it is also said to mean “it happened”, no matter if he was earlier like that or not.

The Quran says:

58:3	again they revert to what they had said earlier	ثُمَّ يَعُودُونَ لِمَا قَالُوا
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“عَادُ” (*aa'idun*): someone who returns, the plural of which is “عَادُونَ” (*aaidoon*) (44:15).
 “أَعَادَ” (*aa'ada*), “يُعِيدُ” (*yu'eedu*): to return (85:13). It may also mean to take one all the way to the destination because “مَعَادُ” (*ma'aadun*) also means destination, last point or result.

Surah *Al-Qasas* says:

28:85	Return to the destination	لَرَأَيْكَ إِلَىٰ مَعَادٍ
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Here it would mean to return because the messenger *Muhammad* would eventually return to the city of *Mecca* where he had once been ostracized by the unbelievers. It also means birth place and home country {T}. If “مَعَادُ” (*ma'aad*) is taken to mean the wanted destination, then it would be more appropriate because a messenger is free from considerations of a home country. The environment which is conducive for his mission and the spread of the revelation becomes home for him (The universe belongs to Allah). As such, the messenger *Muhammad's* return to *Mecca* was not a travel back to his homeland but the completion of his mission. However it is clear that “يُعِيدُ” (*yueed*) does not mean repetition, but to complete a thing by passing it through different phases. One who does this is called “رَبُّ” (*rabb*) in this context. See heading (R-J-Ain).

“أَلْعَاءِدَةُ” (*al-aa'idatu*): favor and good treatment, kindness and benefit {T}.

As such, it is said:

“بِذَا الْأَمْرُ أَعُوذُ عَلَيْكَ” (*haazal amru aa'oodu alaika*): this work or profession is more beneficial for you.
 “فَلَانٌ مَا يُبْدِيءُ وَمَا يُعِيدُ” (*fulanun ma yubdioo yueedu wama yueed*): that man has no strategy or plan and hence he cannot do it the first time nor repeat it {T}.

“الْمُعِيدُ” (*al-mueedu*): a man who can do a work and has become a habitual of it.

“الْمُعِيدُ” (*mueedun*): a male camel who travels repeatedly but does not get tired. It also means a man of who is experienced and wise {T}.

Ibn Faris says that “أَعَادَ لِأَمْرٍ” (*a'ada lil aamar*) means “to possess the strength to do some work”.

The above explanations clearly show that “يُبْدِيءُ” (*yubdi*) or “يُعِيدُ” (*yueed*) in (85:13) does not only mean repetition and intent but also to possess the full might and ability to take something to completion.

For the meaning of “مَبْدَأُ” (*mabdaa*) and “مَعَادُ” (*ma'aad*), see heading (B-D-A).

“الْعِيدُ” (*al-eeedu*): the time when happiness or sorrow returns {T}.

“الْعُودُ” (*al-ood*): every thin or fine piece of wood, as well as wooden fuel {T, M}.

“عَاوُذُ” (*aa’i’zun*): every female who has recently given birth to a child. Plural is “عُوُذُ” (*oozoon*) {*T, M*}.
 “عَاوُذْتُ بِوَالِدِيهَا” (*aazat bi walidiha*): for a mother to stay with her child for protection when a child is young {*T*}.
 “الْمُعَوُذُ” (*al-mu’awwazu*): the grazing field of camels which is near inhabited houses, so that camels can be watched. With regard to this meaning “تَعَوُذُ” (*tu’awwaza*) and “إِسْتَعَاذُ” (*ista’aaz*) would mean to find sanctuary with someone, or to be safe in his protection.
 “عَاذَ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*aaza bish shaiyee*): to stick to something, i.e. hang on to it for life and to adopt it permanently {*T, M*}.

The party which establishes the system of Allah in this world always needs the support and goodwill of the laws of Allah. But in the early days when there are few people and the opponents are strong and large in number, the protection of Allah’s laws and His Sustenance is very much required just like a newly born needs the protection and sustenance from its mother.

This is the stage for which it is said:

113:1	Declare that I am in protection of the Sustainer of the universe	قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ الْعَالَمِ
114:1	Declare that I am in protection of the Sustainer of the mankind	قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ النَّاسِ

This is instruction to always stick to the system and laws of Allah, and never to give them up, and to come under their protection at the slightest sign of danger, and in this way be safe from the machinations of the opposing and rebellious forces.

It has been mentioned above that in the beginning the establishment of Allah’s system needs special help and support of Allah’s laws and “تَعَوُذُ” (*taa’wooz*), but this does not mean that once the system is firmly established the “تَعَوُذُ” (*ta’aw’wooz*) or protection and sustenance of Allah’s laws is no more needed. The protection against rebellious emotions and predilections, and safety from rebellious forces is present with every breath of life. In short, in the beginning one has to revert to the center even for the small matters, but when the system is firmly established with trained and experienced team of people, then small dangers and risks are easily managed locally and automatically. However, the reference to the Quranic values is maintained on a continuous basis as this serves as a standard for all times. Any deviation from this standard means that compromise will set in and the system will commence to go into decline just like disease setting its feet in the body and if goes untreated will harm it irretrievably.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:98	And when you recite this Quran ask for <i>aa’ooz</i> of Allah from <i>Shaitanir rajeem</i> (asking for protection from Allah against all the forces whether known or unknown)	فَإِذَا قَرَأْتَ الْقُرْآنَ فَاسْتَعِذْ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
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Traditionally this is taken to mean that when you start reading or reciting the Quran then you must say “اعوذُ” (*aa’ooz*), or pray for protection against the devil. But the actual meaning is that in order to stay linked to the Quran it is incumbent upon man to not become an ally of rebellious and oppressive forces including ones’ own emotions and desires.

It has been further explained in the next verse:

16:69	the oppressive forces can never prevail upon those who are believers and firmly rely on the protection of the laws of Allah	إِنَّهُ لَيْسَ لَهُ سُلْطَانٌ عَلَى الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَلَى رَبِّهِمْ يَتَوَكَّلُونَ
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This was the way by which the messenger Moses found protection from the oppressive forces of the pharaoh and he said:

40:27	I seek the protection of the Sustainer from the oppressiveness of every powerful and arrogant man.	إِنِّي عُذْتُ بِرَبِّي وَرَبِّكُمْ مِنْ كُلِّ مُتَكَبِّرٍ
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The foregoing is the real meaning of “تَعَوُّذٌ” (*ta’aw’wazun*), i.e. to be linked with the system more strongly when there is danger and follow the laws of Allah more intensely. As against this the meaning of “تَعَوُّذٌ” (*ta’aw’wuz*) is generally taken simply to mean that we have to recite the word “أَعُوْذُ” (*aoozu*) before recitation of the Quran or to make “تَعَوِّذٌ” (*ta’weez*), a written verse and tie the piece of paper around our necks for protection as a talisman. But if we consider the real meaning of “تَعَوِّذٌ” (*ta’weez*) then we will see that there is great change in the meaning. It is true that reciting the Quran is necessary from time to time for believers so that it can be read, understood and be acted upon. But by performing every good deed, especially things pertaining this way of life, we should first seek the protection of Allah from all dark forces, and for that we must say “أَعُوْذُ بِاللهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيْمِ” (*aa’oozo bil laahi minash shaituwanir rajeem*). This means “I seek protection of Allah from the machinations of the oppressive forces”, then it is only a way of expressing the emotions, but it is not right to believe that the real aim is only to repeat these words.

Words are only a means of expressing emotion, but not the end purpose.

“أَعُوْذُ” (*aa’ooz*) and “بِسْمِ الله” (*bismillah*) i.e. seeking protection of Allah and asking for His kindness before beginning anything good are the announcement or manifest of the training.

The Quran says:

2:257	anyone who rejects all those rebellious forces and accepts only the laws of Allah, has latched onto a very dependable support that can never fail	فَمَنْ يَكْفُرْ بِالطَّاغُوتِ وَيُؤْمَرْ بِاللَّهِ فَقَدْ اسْتَمْسَكَ بِالْعُرْوَةِ الْوُثْقَى لَا انْفِصَامَ لَهَا
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ع و ر Ain-W-R

“الْعَوْرُ” (*al-awaru*): loss of eyesight in one eye.

“أَعْوَرُ” (*aa’waru*): one eyed. It also means a crow because among the Arabs, a one eyed man and a crow are thought to bring bad luck. The word is also used to mean a weak, a coward, and a foolish man who has never done any good deed. It also means a man giving directions who is himself not aware of the right direction.

“الْأَعْوَرُ مِنَ الْكُتُبِ” (*al’aaoozu minal kutub*): a book whose words have been rubbed off.

“الْأَعْوَرُ مِنَ الطَّرِيقِ” (*al’aaoozi minat tarqi*): a road without any milestone or any other sign.

“الْعَاءِرُ” (*al-aaeeru*): everything that hurts eyes.

“الْعَوْرَةُ” (*al-auratu*): a breach on border which can be used by the enemy for an attack.

Kitaab-ul-Ashfaaq says that “عَوْرَةُ الْقَوْمِ” (*auratul qoum*) means a place from which a nation fears an enemy attack.

Surah **Al-Ahzaab** says “إِنَّ بَيْتَنَا عَوْرَةٌ” (*inna buyutana auratun*) in (33:13) which means this very thing.

Ibn Faris has also written that “الْعَوْرَةُ” (*al-auratu*) means everything that is vacant or in an empty state which makes its overseeing necessary.

“أَعْوَرَ الشَّيْءُ” (*aa’wazash shjaiyee*): for something to become so manifest that it can be attacked by another.

“الْعَوْرَةُ” (*al-auratu*): every discrepancy which makes prone to fear. It also means everything which invokes shame and modesty, or that which is the cause of distaste. It also means a place of shame of a woman or a man.

The Quran says:

24:31	sexuality of women	عَوْرَاتِ النِّسَاءِ
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This leads to sex related things of women which are generally not spoken about. At another place it is said that it is used to describe the time before the early hours of the morning, and after the night prayer, and in the afternoon when you take rest to straighten your back.

24:58	during these three times your hidden parts are not fully covered	ثَلَاثَ عَوْرَاتٍ لَكُمْ
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The meaning of this verse is that at these times your privacy must be ensured.

Ain-W-Q ع و ق

“الْعَوُقُ” (*al-auqu*): to stop, to give back. It also means a man who has no good in him, as well as a man who stops others from doing good.

“عَاقَتْنِي عَنِ الْأَمْرِ الَّذِي أَرَدْتُ” (*aaqani anil amril lazi adtu*): he stopped or prevented me from doing what I had intended to do.

“التَّعْوِيقُ” (*at-ta'weeq*): to prevent.

“مُعَوِّقٌ” (*mu'awwiq*): someone who prevents {T, M, R}.

The Quran has used “الْمُعَوِّقِينَ” (*al-mu'awwaqeen*) in (33:18).

“عَوَاقِ الدَّهْرِ” (*awaa'eequd dahr*): the vicissitudes of life which make a man concentrate on himself or his own problems and prevent him from other engagements {T, M, R}.

“يَعُوْقُ” (*ya'auqu*) was the name of an idol of the tribe of **Kananah**. Some say that this was the name of an idol during the time of messenger **Nooh** (71:23).

Ain-W-L ع و ل

“الْعَوْلُ” (*al-aul*): anything that is a burden on man that overwhelms him and burdens him {R}.

“عَالَ الشَّيْءِ فَلَانًا” (*aalash shaiyee-u fulana*): that which burdened and worried him, overwhelmed him.

“الْعِيَالُ” (*al-iyaaalu*): the expenses for which a man is responsible; under whose burden a man is laboring.

“أَعَالَ الرَّجُلُ” (*a'aalar rajul*): that man became one with many children, and also that he became a pauper and deprived.

“عَالَ الْمِيزَانُ” (*aa'lal meezanu*): the scale needed some weight as its scales had become lopsided and uneven. From here it started meaning to do injustice.

“عَالَ فِي الْحُكْمِ” (*aala fil hukm*): he was not just in deciding a matter {T, Kitab-ul-Ashfaaq}.

In surah **An-Nisa** where more than one wife has been allowed to meet the needs in an emergency, like during a war time or some other emergency in a society, it has also been said that if you feel that you will be unable to do justice with each wife then only have one wife. The Quran has put strong emphasis on justice and any act which can lead one to injustice will affect the self-development and the Quran accordingly cautions us against this. Our conduct in this life will decide where we go in the hereafter and these injunctions must be seen in this context.

After that it has been said “ذَٰلِكَ أَدْنَىٰ أَلَّا تَعُولُوا” (*zalika adna alla ta'oolu*) in (4:3). One meaning of this verse is that “you should not move away from the truth”. The other meaning is “lest you are burdened by having a large family” {T}. Also see the heading (Ain-Y-L).

“الْعَوْمُ” (*al-aumu*): to swim.

“السَّبْحُ” (*as-sabhu*): to swim with your head above water, and in which the swimmer does not take a dive.

“الْعَوْمُ” (*al-aumu*): to swim under water.

“الْعَامَةُ” (*al-aamatu*): a small boat which can be used to cross a river.

“الْعَوَامُ” (*al-awwaam*): a fast horse {T}.

The Quran says about the celestial bodies:

36:40	every one of them is swimming (floating) on its axis	كُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ
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This “swim” led to the meaning of “year” i.e. the time in which the sun completes its revolution {R}.

Taj-ul-Urooj says that “الْعَامُ” (*al-aam*) and “السَّنَةُ” (*as-sanah*) differ because “السَّنَةُ” (*as-sanah*) means the year when there is drought, whereas “الْعَامُ” (*al-aam*) is said when the year is fruitful and there is contentment {T}. But this is not a rule.

Some say that “السَّنَةُ” (*as-sanah*) means a solar year and “الْعَامُ” (*al-aam*) means a lunar year.

That is why “الْعَامُ” (*al-aam*) is considered smaller compared to “السَّنَةُ” (*as-sanah*).

Surah *Al-Ankabut* says about the messenger *Nooh*:

29:14	He tarried among them a thousand years less fifty	فَلَبِثَ فِيهِمْ أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ إِلَّا خَمْسِينَ عَامًا
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Here both “سَنَةٌ” (*sinatah*) and “عَامٌ” (*aam*) have been used.

As per *Raghib* “سَنَةٌ” (*saanat*) is the time of difficulties and “عَامٌ” (*aam*) the time of happiness {T}.

For further explanation see heading (S-N-W).

“عَوْنٌ” (*aun*): help, also helper {M}.

“عَوَانٌ” (*awanun*): middle aged, i.e. a man between his younger days and old age {T}.

The Quran says:

2:68	That cow is neither young nor old but in between.	لَا فَارِضٌ وَلَا بَكْرٌ عَوَانٌ بَيْنَ ذَلِكَ
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“مُنْعَاوِنَةٌ” (*mutaa'winatun*): a woman who is not young but her body is well knit and does not reflect the age {T}, i.e. she does not have the flamboyance of early adulthood, nor the effervescence of young age, nor the weaknesses of old age. She has reached the maturity of middle age as far as her mind is concerned but her body is still very attractive.

“إِسْتَعَانَ” (*ista'aan*): to wish for moderation and balance for oneself and seek somebody's help to achieve this end (1:4). By this count Allah is called “الْمُسْتَعَانُ” (*al-musta'aan*) in (21:112).

“أَعَانَ” (*a'aan*): to help somebody (18:95).

“تَعَاوَنَ” (*ta'aawun*): to help one another, or to co-operate (5:2).

Keeping the above given meaning of “إِسْتَعَانَ” (*ista'ana*) in mind, verse (1:4) gets very clear:

1:4	we spend all our might and capability according to the laws of Allah and want moderation within ourselves through them	إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ
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Hence it means the moderation that has both maturity and beauty in proper balance. These two wishes go to make a cycle for our life and turn our capabilities with the help of laws of Allah into a perfect balance

and make us use our abilities according to the laws of Allah, through which the universal humanity can attain that balance. This attained through resolute obedience of the Quranic values.

That is why it has been said:

2:45	through resolution and <i>salaat</i> , achieve the maturity and balance in your capabilities	وَأَسْتَعِينُوا بِالصَّبْرِ وَالصَّلَاةِ
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Only this way you can be successful and only by this way you can be helped. This begets the help of Allah (47:7).

Wherever cooperation has been exhorted in the Quran in the works of virtue, this will mean the same co-operation as noted earlier. If someone lacks some ability, then he should be helped in overcoming the weaknesses and this can be turned into his strengths through training and help.

Ain-Y-B ع ي ب

“الْعَيْبُ” (*al-aiibu*): fault, slackness, that which is not right.

“عَابَ الشَّيْءُ” (*aabash shaiy'o*): that thing became faulty.

“عَيْتُهُ” (*ibtuhu*): I made it faulty, I found fault with it {T}.

Surah *Al-Kaif* says:

18:79	I wanted to make it faulty	فَأَرَدْتُ أَنْ أَعِيبَهَا
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“الْعَيْبَةُ مِنَ الرَّجُلِ” (*al-aibatu minar rajul*): the secret place of man.

“الْعِيَابُ” (*al-iyaab*): the chest and the heart, or the baton used in beating cotton wool to make it loose and separate before stuffing it in a quilt or mattress {T}. This highlights the meaning of finding fault and criticism very well.

Ain-Y-R ع ي ر

“الْعَيْرُ” (*al-airu*): a donkey.

“الْعَيْرُ” (*al-iyru*): a caravan of camels that brings crops or foodstuff, or animals which are used for bringing foodstuff whether the animals are camels, donkeys or mules {T}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:70	O you, the caravan	أَيُّهَا الْعَيْرُ
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Ibn Faris says there are two meanings to this:

- 1) For something to jut out upwards
- 2) Coming and going.

“الْعَيْرُ” (*al-aeru*): a raised bone, like the middle bone of the shoulder, the raised bone on the back of the foot. It also means the animals that are beasts of burden, with reference to the coming and going of a caravan.

Ibrani thinks that this is a Hebrew or Syrian word. **Lais** thinks that this word has been culled from “ایشوع” (*ishoo*) {T}. Perhaps this is a different form of “عیسُو” (*eesu*).

Raghib thinks that if this word is of Arab origin then it might have come from the word “الْعَيْسُ” (*al-eesu*) which means “white colored camel with a blackish tinge”.

Taj says that it means “white camels with a brownish tinge”.

The Quran has used this word as the name of the messenger better known as **Jesus** (3:52). At another place this messenger has been called “الْمَسِيحُ عِيسَى ابْنُ مَرْيَمَ” (*al-masihu eesa ibn Maryam*) (3:44), i.e. **Eesa** the son of **Mariam**. He is the last of the messengers among the children of Israel.

When the crimes of the Children of Israel reached a peak, in order to complete the condition of warning (as a permanent value), Allah sent him as a messenger to reform them. He invited them to follow the way of Allah as had been preached by all messengers since Noah. This was to obliterate all evil systems like monarchy, eremitism and capitalism from the world and to establish a society that followed Allah’s law. Obviously this invitation went against the wrong thinking religious leaders at that time and also against the Roman Empire. Thus they ganged up and wanted to punish this messenger at a cross, but Allah foiled this scheme and **Eesa** migrated to another place, even before he could be captured.

When the Jews were unsuccessful in this scheme, they tried another tactic. Paul was an extremist Jew. He adopted Christianity and gradually rose to a saint’s status. It must be remembered that people are pronounced saints after their death. So obviously they must have achieved the saintly status when they were alive. Then gradually he started presenting another religion instead of asking people to follow Christ’s way. The concepts of Christ being God’s son, Jesus being God himself, the concept of Jesus’ atonement for the all humanity and eremitism became the basic beliefs in Christianity, although none of these concepts were subscribed by Jesus himself. The Quran, after making its advent, rejected the allegations against Jesus and his mother Mary on one hand, and rejected all false concepts that Paul and his followers had been propagating as the Christian faith. As history gradually reveals some of the truths, recently the documents retrieved from the Dead Sea throw new light over the realities of that time, the reality is being more and more manifested that whatever the Jews were made to believe about the teachings and life of Jesus, something they still believe, is wrong and the correct facts are those which the Quran has revealed. Details of all these matters can be found in the book titled “*Shola’ee Mastoor*”.

Ain-Y-Sh

ع ی ش

“عَاشَ” (*aasha*), “بَعِشَ” (*ya’eeshu*), “عِيشَا” (*ai’sha*), “مَعَاشَا” (*ma’asha*) and “مَعِيشَتُهُ” (*maee’shata*) all mean “he spent a lifetime”.

“الْعَيْشُ” (*al-aish*): life, to spend a life, since one cannot spend a life without bread.

Even these days “الْعَيْشُ” (*al-aishu*) means bread.

“الْمَعِيشَةُ” (*al-ma’eeshtu*): all edibles, depending on which a life can be spent.

“مَعَايِشُ” (*ma’yish*): the accoutrements of life {T}.

The Quran says:

15:20 7:10	produced the accoutrements or food for life from it	وَجَعَلْنَا لَكُمْ فِيهَا مَعَايِشَ
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As such, all the means of production can be included in the word “land”.

“الْمَعَاشُ” (*al-ma’aash*): the opportunity to look for the accoutrements of life {T}.

“عِيشَتُهُ” (*eeshatun*): life.

78:11	And we made abundance of livelihood	وَجَعَلْنَا السَّمَاءَ رِجَافًا
101:7	His life is in consonance with the laws of Allah, or is of the type that makes Him happy.	فَهُوَ فِي عِيشَةٍ رَاضِيَةٍ

Surah **Taha** says that heaven in which **Adam** had dwelt had the accoutrements of life in abundance. To attain them he did not have to struggle hard (20:117-118). This was man's ancient life in which the mutual interests of men did not clash. After that, man started a social life in which competition began to take place, to get the accoutrements of life, and man began to struggle. To eliminate this cut-throat competition it was advised to follow the laws of Allah. This will make the attainment of sustenance easy (20:123).

After that it is said:

20:124	and the nation that avoids Our code will find its economy narrowed	وَمَنْ أَعْرَضَ عَنْ دِكْرِي فَإِنَّ لَهُ مَعِيشَةً ضَنْكًا
20:124	and We shall raise him blind on the Day of Reckoning	وَنُخْشِرُهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ أَعْمَى

It is quite clear that the nation which does not live according to the laws of Allah has its economy or means of living narrowed or stilted, and that it is deprived of the necessities of life. It becomes penny-less and poor. Then its hereafter also becomes bad.

As such, it is open self-deceit to live a life of paucity in this world and feel confident that this poorness gives rise to our spiritual progress. Affluence and free from deprivation is a life that is a must for the believers in this world because only such a life can ensure good deeds for a **Momin**. Such a life is the necessary outcome of living according to the laws of Allah. Paucity and deprivation are living examples of not living according to the principles enshrined in the Quran. This is the reason why the Quran has given so much importance to the economic life of human beings. In order to achieve this, it has laid down these principles. This is the system which solves all problems, many of which we are facing the world of today. Details of this matter can be found in my book "*Nizaam-e-Rabobiyat*" or "*System of Sustenance*". Also see heading (Ain-M-Y).

Ain-Y-L ع ي ل

Ibn Faris says that the basic meanings of "الْعَيْلَةُ" (*al-ailatu*) are starvation and need.

"عَالَ" (*aala*) or "يَعِيلُ" (*yaeelu*): to become needy.
 "عَاءِلٌ" (*aa'eelun*): needy or deprived {T}.

93:8	Allah found you in need so He gave you so much that you became independent of all others	وَوَحَّدَكَ عَاءِلًا فَاعْنَى
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"الْعَيْلَةُ" (*al-aalatu*): deprivation.
 "الْعِيَالُ" (*al-eeyaalu*) is the plural of "الْعِيَالُ" (*ayyilun*) i.e. the people who are looked after or those whose needs are fulfilled {T}. The plural is "عِيَالٌ" (*ayeel*).

Ain-Y-N ع ي ن

"عَيْنٌ" (*ainu*) has over hundred meanings, but as a root its basic meaning is the eye. All other meanings are variations of this meaning or derivatives of it {T}.

The Quran has used this word to mean the eye, stream or flowing water. The plural forms are "أَعْيُنٌ" (*a'yeen*) and "عُيُونٌ" (*o'yoona*).

"مَعِينٌ" (*ma'eenoon*): rich or fertile land.

"عَيْنًا" (*ainaa*): stream (2:60).

"عَلَى أَعْيُنِ النَّاسِ" (*ala aayu'nin'naas*): in front of people's eyes (21:61).

The Quran says:

23:5	even and fertile land	ذَاتَ قَرَارٍ وَمَعِينٍ
18:86	in a lake or in a sea	تَعْرُبُ فِي عَيْنٍ
37:45	a cup full of flowing water	كَأْسٍ مِنْ مَعِينٍ

Linguists also liken “مَعِينٍ” (*ma’eenoon*) to the word “عَيْنٍ” (*ainun*) as well as to “مَعْنٍ” (*ma’a’noon*). Therefore it has also been mentioned under the heading (M-Ain-N). For the meaning of “مَاعُونٌ” (*ma’oon*) see heading (M-Ain-N).

“أَعْيُنُ” (*aayanu*): a man who has an eye like a wild ox {T}. The Arabs thought such eyes to be very beautiful. Its plural is “عَيْنٌ” (*eenoon*).

This word has been used in verse (37:48) and also in (52:20) where it is said “حُورٍ عَيْنٍ” (*hoorin ain*) i.e. eyes like those of “حُورٍ” (*hoor*). For the meaning of this verse see heading (H-W-R).

“عَيْنٌ” (*eenoon*) is also the plural form of “أَعْيُنُ” (*aayanu*) which is spoken for masculine as well as for “عَيْنَاءُ” (*aina’u*) which is spoken for feminine. As such, “حُورٌ” (*hoor*) is also plural form of both masculine, as well as the feminine singular forms.

Ain-Y-Y ع ي ع

“عَى الرَّجُلُ بِأَمْرٍ” (*ayyar rajulu bil amr*): a man was unable to do some work.
 “عَيَّى عَنْ حُجَّتِهِ” (*ai’yi’ya un hujjatihi*): he was unable to present his argument or reasoning forcefully.
 “أَعْيَا عَلَيْهِ الْأَمْرُ” (*aaya alaihil amr*): that work became difficult for him.
 “أَعْيَا الْمَاشِي” (*aayal maashi*): the walker became tired {T}.
 “الْإِعْيَاءُ” (*al-iy’a’o*): the tiredness that comes from weakness and walking.

The Quran says:

46:33	Allah did not tire after creating the universe	لَمْ يَغْيَ يَخْلُقْهُمْ
50:15	We did not tire after the first creation	أَفَعَيْنَا بِالْخَلْقِ الْأَوَّلِ

This was said in response to those people who were in doubt about further or newer creations. Thus the theory as presented in the Bible has also been contradicted in which it has been said that God created the heavens and the Earth in six days and since He became tired, rested on the seventh day. This 7th day is called the *Yaumi Sabt* or the day of *Sabat* on which the Jews do not work. Allah never gets tired, nor does He sleep/doze (2:45).

“غَبَرَ الشَّيْءُ” (*ghabarash shaiy'o*): something remaining behind or was stopped or left behind.
 “الْغَابِرُ مِنَ اللَّيْلِ” (*al-ghabiru minal lail*): remaining part of night.
 “الْغَبَرُ” (*al-ghabaru*), “الْغُبَارُ” (*al-ghubbaru*) and “الْغَبْرَةُ” (*ghabaratu*): clay or dust.
 “الْغَبْرُ” (*al-gibru*): enmity or something left hidden in the heart, that is, the misery which leaves its mark even after it is over {R, T}.
 “دَابِئَةُ الْغَبْرِ” (*daahiyatul ghabar*): the misery which remains or which is impossible to fend off {T}.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says about the wife of the messenger *Loot*:

7:83	she was one of those who lagged behind (stayed behind)	كَانَتْ مِنَ الْغَابِرِينَ
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Surah *Al-Abas* says:

80:40	dust must have settled on the face	عَلَيْهَا غَبْرَةٌ
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This has been said against “مُسْفِرَةٌ” (*musfiratun*), “ضَا حَكَّةٌ” (*zaahikatun*), “مُسْتَبْشِرَةٌ” (*moostabshiratunn*) in (80:38-39). These words mean sad, worried, and hopeless faces as against smiling and happy faces.

“الْغَبْنُ” (*al-ghabnu*): to misappropriate secretly in some mutual affair or rights against the interests of one's partner or companion. If this misappropriation is done in money matters then it is called “غَبْنٌ فُلَانٌ” (*ghabana fulanun*) but if this misappropriation is in some opinion etc. then it is called “غَبْنٌ” (*ghabina*). Some say the real meaning of “غَبْنٌ” (*ghabnun*) is to hide and “الْغَبْنُ” (*al-ghabanu*): the place where it is hidden {R}.
 “الْمَغْبِينُ” (*al-maghibinu*): the armpit where something is hidden.
 “غَبَنَهُ فِي الْبَيْعِ غَبْنًا” (*ghabanahu fil baiyi ghabna*): he deceived him in business; i.e. gave him some ware in lesser quantity than bargained for or gave him some bad ware {T}.
 “غَبِنَ رَأْيَهُ” (*ghabina raayahu*): his witticism and cleverness became reduced {M}.

The Quran has described *Qiyamat* as “يَوْمُ التَّغَابُنِ” (*yaumut taghaboon*) (24:9).

Raghib says this means that a day when results of the human accountability will manifest i.e. from the perspective of the believers who had pledged their wealth and life according to the guidance of Allah and His laws (9:111). In other words, it means the day on which it will be revealed that the beliefs of the people which they had made in this life were whether right or wrong {R}.

Regarding the manifestation of results the Quran has said that every person will know the value of his deeds and it will also be manifested as to how much is lacking in reaching the standard of success (101:6-8) as such “يَوْمُ التَّغَابُنِ” (*yaumut taghaboon*) (24:6) would mean the time when everyone will know how much the others lack in good deeds; the slackness in good deeds is actually the slackness in the abilities which a person requires to move on to the next stage of life; as such “يَوْمُ التَّغَابُنِ” (*yaumut taghaboon*) is the time of results when everyone's balance will be known; in this world it is time for “تَغَابُنٌ” (*taghaboon*) at every step i.e. at every step you have to struggle against opposing forces and inner temptations to keep your belief (*Iman*) free of adulteration.

“تَغَابُنٌ” (*taghaboon*): to make less or misappropriate the wealth or rights of others, or to deceive each other in a secretive way. The Quran has recorded the mutual accusation of people. As such, according to this explanation it is possible that this day has been called “يَوْمُ التَّغَابُنِ” (*yaumut taghaboon*), although there will be no chance for anyone to misappropriate someone's wealth or rights. Thus it can be understood that on that day the results of the misappropriations, or the deceptions that were carried out in this earthly life, will come to fore.

“الْعَنَاءُ” (*al-ghasha'o*): the froth and waste matter, or the garbage and dead leaves that are brought in by a flood. It also means a rotten thing {*T, M*}. This word is also used for the garbage which is of no use at all. This is a word used for anything that is wasted and destroyed in a state of helplessness and which nobody cares about {*R*}.

The Quran says about a nation that is destroyed as a consequence of their wrong doings:

23:41	We turned them into garbage and thus they were destroyed	فَجَعَلْنَاهُمْ عَنَاءً
13:17	Revolution drives away this garbage	فَاخْتَمَلَ السَّيْلُ زَبَدًا رَابِيًا

This is the condition of a nation which is totally destroyed, but there are nations which exist as the subservient nations to powerful ones. Their condition is like the garbage that a flood drives with it and which is totally powerless and has nowhere else to go besides wherever the flood takes it.

“غَدَرٌ” (*ghadr*): to create a fault in something and leave it;
 “اغْدَرَهُ” (*aghdarahu*), “غَادَرَهُ” (*ghdarahu*): he left it {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

18:47	We did not spare anyone of them	فَلَمْ نَعَادِرْ مِنْهُمْ أَحَدًا
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“الْغَدْرُ” (*al-ghudaru*): a promise or pact breaker and unfaithful.
 “الْغَدِيرُ” (*al-ghadeeru*): a pond or the body of water which the flood leaves behind.
 “الْغَدْرُ” (*al-ghadru*): leave someone's companionship. It is the opposite of faithfulness {*T, R*}.
 “غَدِرَتِ الشَّاةُ” (*ghadaratish shatu*): a goat was left behind by other goats {*Ibn Faris*}.

“الْغَدَقُ” (*al-ghadaqu*): too much, prolific, in abundance {*R, Ibn Faris*}.
 “اغْدَقَ الْمَطَرُ” (*aghdal maaru*): it rained a lot.
 “غَدَقَتِ الْأَرْضُ” (*ghadaqatil arzu*): the ground became green.
 “هُمْ فِي غَدَقٍ مِنَ الْعَيْشِ” (*hoom fee ghadaqin minal aish*): those people live a life of wellbeing because they have an abundance of sustenance {*T, Kitab-ul-Ashfaq*}.

The Quran says:

72:116	We grant them abundant sustenance	لَا سَقِيَّةَ لَهُمْ مَاءٌ غَدَقًا
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“الْغُدْوَةُ” (*al-ghudwaatu*): early in the morning, or the early part of the day {*R*}.
 “غَدَا عَلَيْهِ غُدْوًا” (*ghada alaihi ghuduwwa*): went to him early morning {*T*}.
 “وَإِذَا غَدَوْتَ مِنْ أَهْلِكَ” (*wa ghadauta min ahlik*): and when you left early in the morning (3:120).
 “الْغَدَا” (*al-gha*): the coming morrow, tomorrow. This word is also used for the future.
 “مَا قَدَّمْتُ لَغَدَا” (*ma qaddamat lighud*): i.e. whatever he has saved or sent ahead for the future (59:18).
 “غَدَاءٌ” (*ghada'oon*): the food of the day that is eaten early in the morning (18:63).
 “غَدَا” (*ghada*) is an intransitive verb which means the same as “صَارَ” (*saar*), that is, for something to reach some state {*M*}.

Surah *Airaaf* says “غُدُوْا” (*ghuduwu*) which is plural of “غُدُوَّةٌ” (*ghudawatu*). It has been used against “أَصَالٌ” (*aasalun*) in (7:205).

“غَدُوَّةٌ” (*ghadwatun*) has appeared opposite of “عَشِيٌّ” (*ashiyun*) in (6:54). Here it means evening as compared to morning. The “و” (*wao*) in “غَدُوَّةٌ” (*ghadwatun*) is silent. Hence it is pronounced as “غَدَاةٌ” (*ghadatun*). Surah *Saba* has used “غَدُوٌّ” (*ghuduwwun*) against “رَوَاحٌ” (*rawahun*) in (34:1). That is passing of the morning and the advent of the evening.

Ibn Faris says that this root is concerned with time.

Gh-R-B

غ ر ب

The Arabic dictionary has lots of meanings for “الْغَرْبُ” (*al-gharb*), but the following are more popular:

- 1) Western direction. Anything connected with west it is called “غَرْبِيٌّ” (*gharbiyyun*).
- 2) To go.
- 3] To leave or be separated from {T}.

Ibn Faris says that there is no set rule for the root of this word.

“غُرُوبُ الشَّمْسِ” (*ghurubsh shams*): the disappearance of the sun or the sunset in the west.
 “غَرَبَ الشَّمْسُ تَغْرُبُ” (*gharabatish shamsu taghroobu*): the sun set.
 “مَغْرِبُ الشَّمْسِ” (*maghrbus shamsi*), “مَغْرِبَانِ الشَّمْسِ” (*maghribush shamsi*) and “مُغَيِّرٌ بِأَنفِهَا” (*mughairi bi' anuha*): the time or place of sunset {T}.

For all references where this word has appeared against “” (*sharq*), see heading (*Sh-R-Q*).

“غَرَبَ فُلَانٌ” (*gharaba fulan*), “غَرَبَةٌ” (*ghurbat*), “غُرْبًا” (*ghurba*): that man went away from the homeland {T}.
 “غَرِيبٌ” (*ghareeb*): a traveler or a stranger and
 “غُرْبَةٌ” (*ghurbat*): the state of travelling or strangeness.

In Urdu this has led to the term “غريب الوطن” (*gharibul watan*) i.e. a man who has left his home country for abroad.

“غَرِيبٌ” (*gharib*) means pauper in Urdu, but in Arabic it means a traveller and a stranger.
 “غُرَابٌ” (*ghurabun*): a crow (5:31) because it can go very far {R}.
 “غُرَيْبٌ” (*ghirbibun*): black colour {T}.
 “غَرَابِيبُ سُودٌ” (*gharabibun soodun*): very black, or pitch black (35:27).
 “غُرُوبِيهَا” (*gurubiha*) has appeared opposite of sunrise in (20:130).

Gh-R-R

غ ر ر

“غَرَّهَ” (*gharrah*), “يَغُرُّهُ” (*yaghurrohu*): deceived him and gave him false hope {T}.
 “الْمَغْرُورُ” (*al-maghror*): a man who thinks that the woman he has wedded is a free woman but later finds out that she was a slave {T}.
 “غَرُورٌ” (*gharur*): anything that deceives a man or makes him believe in fraud.
 “غَارَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*gharratin naqatu*): the camel's milk lessened although it was not expected of her. In other words the camel ‘deceived’ {R}.

The basic meaning of this root is deception or to be deceived.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:23	their imaginations deceived them	وَاغْرَرَهُمْ
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In Surah *Luqmaan* “غُرُورٌ” (*ghururun*) (31:33) is used to mean someone who deceives, or anything that may deceive a man.

In Surah *Bani Israel* “غُرُورًا” (*ghururan*) has been used to mean deception (17:64) or while deceiving.

Surah *Al-Infitar* says about the human being:

‘..verily, the promise of Allah is true: let not then this life deceive you ...’ (31:33)

In other words the above verse is saying that you should not be held deceived regarding your Sustainer.

Muheet has said that “مَا عَرَكَ بِرَبِّكَ الْكَرِيمَ” (*ma gharrka bifulanin*) means “how come you became brave about *fulan*?” or “how did you build up courage against Him?” (82:6).

Another meaning of this verse can also be “how dare you believe in your own laws instead of following laws of the Sustainer?”

“الْغَرَّةُ” (*al-gharra*): the fold of cloth;

“الْغُرَّةُ” (*al-ghurratu*): the best part of anything, the whiteness {*Ibn Faris*}. The Quran has not used these words.

Gh-R-F غ ر ف

“الْغَرْفَةُ” (*al-gharfatu*): to fetch water in the fold of hands.

“الْغِرْفَةُ” (*al-ghirfatu*): the way water is held in the palm of hands.

“الْغُرْفَةُ” (*al-ghurfatu*): that which is held in the palm of hands. Its plural is “الْغُرَافُ” (*al-ghirafu*).

2:249	he took out some water with his hands	إِغْتَرَفَ الْمَاءَ يَدَيْهِ
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“نَاقَةٌ غَارِفَةٌ” (*naaqatun aarifatun*): a fast she camel.

“الْغَرَفُ” (*al-gharraf*): a river with abundant water.

“الْغُرْفَةُ” (*al-ghurfatu*): the upper room, or balcony. Its plural is “غُرَفٌ” (*ghurafoon*) or “غُرَفَاتٌ” (*ghurufaat*) {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says the various meanings of this word do not follow any rule.

Surah *Al-Furqan* says about the believers:

27:75	They shall be paid according to their <i>gurfatu</i>	أُولَئِكَ يُجْزَوْنَ الْغُرْفَةَ بِمَا صَبَرُوا
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This meaning includes abundance and loftiness. Also see (29:58), (34:37), and (39:20).

It also means to progress in life and to traverse the evolutionary stages nicely.

Note how the Quran has said all this through the use of one composite word. It includes the abundance of the accoutrements of life, successes, to traverse the stages of life successfully, and to traverse from this life to the hereafter.

“غَرِقَ” (*ghariq*), “يَغْرُقُ” (*yaaghraqu*), “غَرَقًا” (*gharaqan*): to be submerged in water.

Some say “غَرَقَ” (*gharqun*) means to take in so much water through the nose that it causes death.

Ibn Faris says the actual meaning of this root is to reach the last and extreme point of anything.

“الْغَرِيقَةُ” (*al-ghariqatu*): land that is very well irrigated.

“أَغْرَقَ النَّازِعُ فِي الْقَوْسِ” (*aghraqun naazi'oo fil qausi*): the man who was stringing the bow stretched it to its extreme limit.

“إِغْرَاقُ” (*ighraqun*): to pull a bow to its extreme limit.

“غَرَقًا” (*gharqa*) has been used in place of “إِغْرَاقًا” (*izraqan*) in verse (79:1) in meanings of stretching something to its very extreme limit {T}.

“أَغْرَقَهُ” (*agh'raqahu*): drowned him {T}.

Surah *Yunus* says about the Pharaoh:

10:90	when he was about to be drowned	إِذَا أَدْرَكَهُ الْعَرَقُ
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About drowning, Surah *Al-Airaf* says:

7:136	So We drowned them	فَأَغْرَقْنَاهُمْ
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Those who are drowned will be called “مُغْرَقٌ” (*maghraqun*). Its plural is “مُغْرَقُونَ” (*mughraqoon*) or “مُغْرَقِينَ” (*mughraqueen*) as used in (44:24).

“الْغُرْمَى” (*al-ghurma*): a burdensome woman.

“الْغَرَامُ” (*al-gharaam*): a permanent nuisance. It also means harshness and misery or the intense misery that does not end and is difficult to get rid.

“الْغُرْمُ” (*al-ghurm*): ransom or fine, i.e. unnecessary payment which has to be made, or a fine that has to be paid for no reason. Hence it is also used for a misery which does not leave one alone.

“الْغَرِيمُ” (*al-ghareem*) is used for both the lender and the borrower. It is used for the borrower because he is laboring under the debt and for the lender because “الْمُغْرَمُ” (*al-mughram*) means a lover who follows his beloved wherever he goes or because he has to keep an eye on his loan or the borrower.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is to stick to another.

The Quran says “الْغَارِمِينَ” (*al-gharimeen*) in (9:10). It can mean a borrower as well as one who is miserable. It may also mean those who have to pay ransom or face some loss.

“غَرِمَ فِي التَّجَارَةِ” (*al-gharima fit tijarati*): suffered a loss in business.

“مُغْرَمًا” (*maghramun*): ransom or fine for nothing (9:98).

Surah *Al-Waqiya* says:

56:66	We had to face a fine or ransom for no fault of ours	إِنَّا لَمُعْرِمُونَ
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Surah *Al-Furqan* says about the punishment in hell:

2:65	The punishment is such that it will not leave you (You will get stuck with it).	إِنَّ عَذَابَهَا كَانَ غَرَامًا
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“غِرَاءٌ” (*ghira’oon*): a thing that is stuck on to another like glue {*R*}. From this “إِغْرَاءٌ” (*ighra’oon*) started meaning to stick something on to something else.

“أَغْرَى الْكَلْبَ بِالصَّيْدِ” (*aghral kalba bis sayd*): the dog was totally focused on the hunting target {*T*}. Hence this word means to make somebody pursue someone or to stay on him.

Surah *Al-Ma’ida* says:

5:14	We made enmity compulsory between them	فَأَغْرَيْنَا بَيْنَهُمُ الْعَدَاوَةَ
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“أَغْرَاهُ بِهِ” (*aghrahu bihi*): to make one love something or become fond of something and to incite one to this emotion {*M*}. Therefore it means to make someone pursue someone {*T*}.

Surah *Al-Ahzaab* says:

33:60	We shall make you rise against them	لَتَغْرِيَنَّكَ بِهِمْ
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In other words this verse means “in order to punish them, We shall make you pursue them”.

“غَزَلٌ” (*ghazlun*): to spin thread from raw cotton. It also means the cotton which has been woven into thread {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

16:92	one who unraveled his own thread that he had spun	نَقَضَتْ غَزْلَهَا
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“الْغَزَلُ” (*al-ghazalu*): to talk sweet to women.

“الْغَزَالُ” (*al-ghazaalu*): the child of a deer when it starts to walk and move around.

“الْغَزَالَةُ” (*al-ghazalatu*): the sun, because it spreads its rays around the earth like threads {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says that the above three meanings are the basic meanings of this root even though each one is different from the others.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:92	Beware lest you become like the woman who spins thread and then unravels it herself	وَلَا تَكُونُوا كَالَّتِي نَقَضَتْ غَزْلَهَا مِنْ بَعْدِ قُوَّةٍ أَنْكَاةً
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This is a point to ponder because it highlights our scientific theories and then unraveling of those theories after further facts come to light whereas the revelation gives us concrete truth without experiment and any effort and prevents us from a loss of time which sometimes can be centuries.

The revelation is inherently more precious than the trial and error method adopted by scientists and saves us a lot of trouble and is never contradicted, while the story of human development is the story of trial and error.

“غَزَاهُ” (*ghazahu*) and “غَزَوْا” (*ghazwa*): intended to do something, planned to do something, called for it. These are the basic meanings of this root, i.e. intent and demand.

“غَزَوِي كَذَا” (*ghazvi kaza*): my intent is this or such {T}.

“مَغْزَى الْكَلَامِ” (*maghzal kalam*): the intent {T}. Later this word came to mean the intent towards an enemy.

“غَزَا الْعَدُوَّ” (*ghazaal aduwwu*): he came out with the intent to fight his enemy.

Thus we see that “غَزَوْ” (*ghazwun*) includes intent, purpose as well as battle. The intent and purpose of the group of believers is always subject to Allah’s will and laws, therefore their battles are only to remove oppression and tyranny and not to harass the weak and for looting them.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:155	Or they are engaged in battle	أَوْكَانُوا غَزَى
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“الْأَسَقُ” (*al-asaqu*) is the darkness at the beginning of the night {T}. *Raghib* says it means pitch darkness.

Ibn Faris says this root means darkness.

The Quran says:

17:78	till the darkness of the beginning of the night	إِلَى غَسَقِ اللَّيْلِ
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“الْأَغَاسِقُ” (*al-ghasiq*): the moon when it becomes black due to the eclipse. It also means dark night {T}.

The Quran says:

113:3	And from the devastation darkness when it falls	مِنْ شَرِّ غَاسِقٍ إِذَا وَقَبَ
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Raghib says this means the misery or the accident that takes place at night. It is very similar to “طَارِقُ” (*tariq*) which means a person who comes at night {R}.

“غَاسِقٌ” (*ghasiqun*): cold. As such the night is called “غَاسِقٌ” (*ghasiq*) because it is colder than the day {T}.

“غَسَّاقٌ” (*ghassaaq*): a very cold thing, a thing whose coldness creates a burning sensation.

Surah *An-Naba* says in (78:25) that *jahannum* or a hellish society holds “حَمِيمًا” (*hameem*) and “غَسَّاقًا” (*ghassaaq*). Here “غَسَّاقٌ” (*ghassaaq*) means severe cold, or the coldness which numbs. Hence there is severe heat and cold in *Jahannam*. Both of these are reasons for annihilation. A field of crop can be destroyed by intense heat as well as by frost. Balance of temperature in all sustenance is absolutely necessary. A crop requires water but if the water is excessive then the crop rots and is destroyed. The wind is essential for trees but when the same wind turns into a hurricane then it uproots the trees. Heat in the right amount is necessary for the plants but when this heat is excessive the plants burn up. Thus *jahannum* doesn’t only mean the deprivation from the means of development, but it also means the imbalance in those means. In the latter case the result is even worse. The furnishing of the accoutrements of life in the right balance can be obtained only from the system of Allah’s sustenance which turns this world into a heaven. It will be the same in the hereafter. We should remember that what permanent values are applicable here, the same are applicable in other parts of the universe(s) as well as all is created by Allah.

“غَسَلَ” (*ghasal*): to wash, to clean something by washing it with water {T}.

“فَاغْسِلُوا وُجُوهَكُمْ” (*faghsilu wujuhakum*): wash your faces (5:6).

“اِغْتَسَلَ” (*ighatasal*): to bathe (4:43)

“مُغْتَسِلٌ” (*mughtassal*): the place where a bath takes place or the water that is used for bathing (38:42) {R}.

Surah *Al-Haqq* says about the people in *jahannum*:

69:36	And they will not have anything to drink besides very hot water	وَلَا طَعَامَ إِلَّا مِنْ غَسِيلٍ
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Generally it is said to mean water that has been used to wash wound, but *Qamoos* says it means anything very hot. Also see heading (*Gh-S-Q*).

“غَشِيَ” (*ghasia*): to cover something completely or overwhelm it completely.

“غَشَا وَ” (*ghishawatun*): the cover that completely covers something or overwhelms it (2:7).

“غَاشِيَةٌ” (*ghasia'tun*): the membrane that covers the heart. The same is said for the leather that covers the sheath of a sword.

“غُشِيَ عَلَيْهِ” (*ghashia alaih*) is said when a person becomes unconscious because this is when a person's senses become completely hidden or nonexistent.

“غَشِيَ فُلَانًا” (*ghashia fulana*): that man came to so and so man.

“غَشِيَهَا” (*ghashiyaha*) and “تَغَشَّاهَا” (*ta'ash'shaha*): to have sex with a woman, because in this state the man covers a woman {T, F}.

The Quran says:

7:189	He covers her	تَغَشَّاهَا
71:7	they covered their hearts	وَاسْتَعَشَّوْا ثِيَابَهُمْ

“غَشَاوَةٌ” (*ghishawat*): curtain (2:7).

“غَشِيَتْ” (*ghashiya*): to cover (20:78).

Surah *Al-Airaaf* has used “مَهَابٌ” (*mahaad*) as opposite of “وَاشٍ” (*ghiwash*) against it in (7:21), which would mean “to put on or wear”.

“الْغَاشِيَةُ” (*al-ghashiyatu*): a misery that comes from all sides (88:1), i.e. the manifestation of the result of deeds of man which surround man from all sides.

As such it is said:

2:19	necessary consequences of the laws of Allah encircle the unbelievers from all directions	وَاللَّهُ مُحِيطٌ بِالْكَافِرِينَ
9:49	<i>jahannam</i> encircles the unbelievers from all sides	إِنَّ جَهَنَّمَ لَمُحِيطَةٌ بِالْكَافِرِينَ

“غَصَبَهُ” (*ghasabahu*), “يَغْصِبُهُ” (*baghsibhu*) or “غَصَبًا” (*ghasba*): to snatch something from someone in a rage.

“غَصَبَ الْجِلْدَ” (*ghasabal jild*): to clean a hide of a hair on it by snatching the tufts of the hair, or to snatch the tufts of wool {T}. There is an element of snatching in this root.

“غَصَبَ الرَّجُلُ الْمَرْأَةَ” (*ghasabar rajulu mar’atah*): the man forcibly raped a woman {M}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:79	the king used to snatch every boat forcibly	يَا خُذْ كُلَّ سَفِينَةٍ غَصْبًا
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This is what happens in every man made system i.e. the powerful wrench means of sustenance or the resources from the weak. That is why Allah’s system made its appearance so that the weak are freed from oppressiveness and cruelty and are also saved from exploitation.

“الْغُصَّةُ” (*al-ghussartuh*): for some edible to get stuck in the throat.

“شَرَقَ” (*sharaqun*): for a liquid to disturb the throat.

“شَجَا” (*shaja*): for a solid thing to get stuck in the throat.

But more often the above difference is not maintained {T}.

This word is also used when the throat gets closed due to anger or some other emotion {M}.

“أَغَصَّ فُلَانٌ عَلَيْنَا الْأَرْضَ” (*aghassa fulanun alainal ard*): someone made this earth too difficult for us to live on.

“فَغَصَّتْ بِنَا” (*fa’ghassat bina*): the earth became too hot for us {T}.

“الْغُصَّةُ” (*al-ghissatu*): also used to mean sadness and worry.

The Quran says about *jahannum*:

73:13	food which gets stuck in throat	وَطَعَامًا ذَا غُصَّةٍ
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Here it means the food which is begotten through humiliation in this life and is difficult for a man to accept or to reject it. Therefore it means something which is not in line with the revelation and which demeans one and makes one unable to progress in the hereafter. Note that the same sustenance which is necessary for human survival becomes the cause of loss when it is stuck in the throat. This is the difference between something which legitimate and not legitimate under the permanent values.

Ibn Faris says that basic meaning of this root denotes intensity and power.

“غَضَبٌ” (*ghazabun*): lion. It also means dark red color or any dark red thing {T}.

“غَضَبٌ رِضًا” (*ghazaboon riza*) is the opposite of willingness. Some have described the meaning of this word as the sudden flow of blood to the head in vengeance.

The meaning of Allah’s *ghazab* is the punishment received for unfaithfulness towards his laws {T}.

“غَضِبَتِ الْفَرْسُ عَلَى اللَّجَامِ” (*ghazibatil farsu alal hijjaam*): a horse who chewed on its bit in anger.

“غَضَبٌ” (*ghazabo*): for a fire to flare up.

“غَضَبَةٌ” (*ghazbato*): a pimple that grows on the eye lid.

“غِضَابٌ” (*ghizabo*): a skin disease in which the entire body becomes red (e.g. small pox).

“مَغْضُوبٌ” (*maghzubo*): a patient who suffers from the said disease.
 “غَضَابٌ” (*ghuzaabo*): a man with a thick, hard skin.
 “غَضَابِيٌّ” (*ghuzaabyo*): one who is rather testy with his companions and hard with the opponents {T}.
 “الْغَضْبَةُ” (*al-ghazbat*): a hard rock.
 “الْغَضُوبُ” (*al-ghazoob*): a big snake {F}.

By using “غَضَبٌ” (*ghazabo*) opposite of “نِعْمَةٌ” (*nimat*) in (19:7), the Quran has clarified what Allah’s *ghazab* or rebellion to His laws and denial can beget, i.e. the opposite of every aspect of Allah’s benevolence.

The Quran has made it clear that the consequence of Allah’s *ghazab* is deprivation and demeaning (2:61) by saying “غَضَبٍ مِنَ اللَّهِ” (*azaaboon minallah*). At another place it has been likened to “عَذَابٌ مُهِينٌ” (*azaaboon muheen*) which means demeaning punishment (2:91).

Surah *Al-Ahzaab* has described Allah’s *ghazab* as:

7:71	We uprooted the nation which used to describe our laws as false	وَقَطَعْنَا دَابِرَ الَّذِينَ كَذَبُوا بآيَاتِنَا
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Thus it is clear that Allah’s *ghazab* entrails individual and collective destruction. It shows the enormous strength of the Law of reutil. It must be understood here that when the Quran mentions Allah’s *ghazab* then it doesn’t mean the emotional outburst or anger of human beings, because Allah is much above the human emotions. Everything that takes place is according to His law and is well thought out and the best possible manifestation of His laws – all explained in the Quran in detail. As such Allah’s *ghazab* is the natural consequences of human conduct which is not in line with the permanent values as given in the Quran.

Surah *Al-Airaf* has said “غَضَبَانَ” (*ghazbaan*) in (7:150) i.e. in a rage, full of anger.

Surah *Al-Ambiya* says “مُغَاضِبًا” (*mughaziba*) in (21:78) i.e. in anger, in displeasure, but both these words have not been used for Allah. The first mention is about the messenger *Moosa* and the other is about the messenger *Yunus*.

Gh-Zd-Zd غ ض ض

“الْغَضُّ” (*al-ghazza*): to lessen, whether it is by seeing or through the eyes, whether it is in voice, or in some other thing {R}.

“غَضَّ مِنْهُ يَغْضُ” (*ghazza minhu yaghuz*): he lessened it.

“غَضَّ الْغُصْنَ” (*ghazzal ghusna*): he broke the branch, but this breaking is such that the breaking is not done fully, therefore basically it means to make subservient, to force to surrender or to lessen.

“الْغَضِيضُ مِنَ الطَّرْفِ” (*al-ghazizu minat turf*): a look in which eyelids are not raised, i.e. a very shy look.

“الْغَضُّ” (*al-ghazzu*): a fresh thing which has not seen much time.

“إِنْغِضَاضُ الطَّرْفِ” (*al-ghizaazut turf*): the closure of the eyes {T}.

Ibn Faris says this roots basic meanings are to stop and lessen, and also freshness and suppleness.

The Quran says “أَبْصَارٌ” (*absar*) in (24:30) where it means to keep the eyes lowered or not to see things which it is forbidden to see {M}.

“صَوْتٌ” (*sau-tun*): to keep the voice lowered (31:19). In both instances there is the element of gentlemanliness as against boldness. Hence it means to make suppliant, or to make less, or to keep controlled, or not allow being intrusive or stare, the eyes as well as voice. This is the way that men and women behave in a Quranic society, i.e. their views are not bold and their voices are not loud or without balance.

“غَطَشَ” (*ghatash*), “يَغْطِشُ” (*baghtishu*): went dark.
 “أَغْطَشَ” (*agh-tasha*), “يُغْطِشُ” (*yugh-tishu*): to darken.
 “لَيْلٌ غَاطِشٌ” (*lailun ghaatishun*): dark night.
 “فَلَاةٌ غَطْشَاءُ” (*falatu ghat-sha’oo*): a desert where one cannot find a way out or find the way.
 “الْغَطْشُ فِي الْعَيْنِ” (*al-ghatashu fil ain*): the dizziness or fuzziness of the eyes.
 “أَغْطَشَ” (*agh-tash*): a man who cannot see clearly {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

76:28	he turned his night into a dark one	أَغْطَشَ لَيْلَهَا
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“الْغِطَاءُ” (*al-ghita’o*): something with which another thing is covered, the cover.

Raghib says that “غِطَاءٌ” (*ghita’o*) is a cover i.e. sort of a utensil and “غِشَاءٌ” (*ghisa’o*) is a cloth like thing with which another thing is covered.

Misbah says “غِطَاءٌ” (*ghita’o*) means curtain.

“الْغِطَايَةُ” (*al-ghitayah*) is the internal wear like a vest which women use as an internal dress and wear another dress over it.

Johri says that if a thing is loftier and longer than some other thing then it is called “غَطَايَتُهُ” (*ghata ilaih*).

“غَطَبَتِ الشَّجَرَةُ” (*ghatit shajaratah*): the branches of a tree became long and spread on ground.
 “غَطَى اللَّيْلُ” (*ghatal lail*): night became dark {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran has used the word “غُطَاءٌ” (*ghit’a*) to mean curtain or unawareness.

18:101	their eyes were behind curtain about My laws (they were unaware of My laws)	كَانَتْ أَعْيُنُهُمْ فِي غِطَاءٍ عَنْ ذِكْرِي
2:7	there is a curtain over their eyes	عَلَى أَبْصَارِهِمْ غِشَاوَةٌ

Muheet with reference to the *Keys* has said that “غَفَرٌ” (*ghaf’r*) means to cover somebody in such a wear that protects him from garbage or unclean things etc. {*M*}. As such there are elements of safekeeping and hiding in this word.

“غَفَرٌ” (*ghaf’r*): to hide behind a cover.

“غَفَرَ الْمَتَاعُ فِي الْوَعَاءِ” (*ghafaral mata’aa fil wi’aa’ee*): to hide goods in some utensil {*T*}, and in this way keep it safe.

“الْمِغْفَرُ” (*al-mighfaru*) and “الْغِفَارَةُ” (*al-ghifaratu*): armor built from iron rings that is worn underneath the main armor and which covers the shoulders and neck so that the wearer can be kept safe from any attack of a sword or a spear, etc.

“الْغِفَارَةُ” (*al-ghifaratu*): a band alike wear which women use on their heads so that their head wear is kept safe from the oil in their hair. Then they also wear a cloth sheet over it.

“الْحِمَاءُ الْغَفِيرُ” (*al-hamma’ol ghafitu*): the hood that covers the entire head and thus keeps it safe {*T*}.

“الْغَفْرُ” (*al-ghafru*) and “الْغُفْرَانُ” (*al-ghufraan*) also mean the same thing {*F*}.

So this makes the meaning of “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*) clear i.e. protection. When a nation adopts the wrong path then the effects of this wrong path start appearing gradually. But if a nation progresses so far down

the wrong road that it is put into annihilation, and repents and adopts the right path, then it undergoes a double effect. One effect is that it is protected from annihilation and the good effects of the right path start appearing on the horizon. In order to make these good results permanent the issue of protection is also quite necessary. This is like first adopting preventive techniques and then undertaking curative procedures. In the same way it is necessary for a healthy man to continue to take a regular diet of healthy food which can contribute to his development.

1) If a nation working on the wrong path at some stage wants to reform and turns for guidance and solace under the laws of Allah then such energy begins to form within itself which protects it from the former wrong path. This is its “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*).

The process of reforming ones wrongs is called “تَوْبَةٌ” (*taubah*). See heading (*T-W-B*).

2) A nation that follows the laws of Allah is protected from the machinations of the destructive forces which continue to plan the nation’s destruction. This is their “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*).

3) To create such forces within self that will protect from the effects of destructive elements by following the laws of Allah and collectively continue to provide the means of protection for a nation is to ask for Allah’s protection or “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*).

As such the author of *Muheet* says that “اِسْتِغْفَارٌ” (*al-istighfaar*) means to strive for reform through words and deed or to ask for Allah’s protection. “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*) means to save a man from the punishment that he has rendered himself prone to by following a wrong path {*M*}.

Taj-ul-Uroos says “غَفَرَ الْأَمْرَ بِغُفْرَاتِهِ” (*ghafarat amra bighuf’ratihi*) means “he straightened the matter in such a way as was required to put it right” {*T*}.

We generally believe that “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*) means for Allah to forgive the sins of a person. The concept of blessed forgiveness is against the concept of the Quran. With reference to the law of requital every deed has a consequence. Wrong deeds produce wrong results and good deeds produce positive results. The act of blessing forgiveness for a wrong deed which is going have a wrong result is a meaningless thing. This concept is the product of the monarchy/dictatorships where the king/rules used to forgive the crime or faults of his subjects according to his will.

The Quranic reward for good deeds is the environment of *jannat*. This can only be achieved through good deeds and not through some benevolence. The Quran says that good deeds create a force within a person that protects him from evil forces. This is the Quranic meaning of “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*) of Allah.

We see that a weakened man is quickly attacked by some disease than others. This means that this man’s protective or defensive forces have become weak hence he cannot fight the germs successfully. The only cure is that this man develops enough strength to fight the germs and defeat them. The creation of such protective forces within oneself is called “اِسْتِغْفَارٌ” (*istighfaar*). Obviously this strength cannot be obtained simply by repeating words like “اَسْتَغْفِرُ اللَّهَ” (*astaghfirullah*) over and over again over some bead string. This can be obtained only through deeds that can develop the growth of a person.

Allah is Merciful i.e. by following His laws this sort of energy can be created and it is incumbent upon the *momins* that they continue to do this “اِسْتِغْفَارٌ” (*istighfaar*), i.e. do good deeds that create this protective force within themselves.

As such the Quran says “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*) in (2:221) and “غُفْرَانٌ” (*ghufraan*) in (2:285). These words mean protection and sanctuary.

“غَافِرٌ” (*ghaafir*) in (7:155), “غُفُورٌ” (*ghafoor*) in (7:153) and “غَفَّارٌ” (*ghaffar*) in (20:82) would mean one who provides protection with the difference that “غَافِرٌ” (*ghaafir*) is a verbal noun or gerund and “غُفُورٌ” (*ghafoor*) and “غَفَّارٌ” (*ghaffaar*) are nouns of exaggeration.

As has been said under the heading (Ain-F-W), “عَفُو” (*afwun*) means to remove the effects of the bad deeds after punishment.

“مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*): to protect one even from the beginning of those effects.

As such the Quran has used “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*) against punishment in (2:175), (3:128).

In verse (2:268) of Surah *Al-Baqrah* “مَغْفِرَةٌ” (*maghfirat*) has been used against “فَقْرٌ” (*faqroon*) to means protection from deprivation and poverty.

Gh-F-L غ ف ل

“غَفَّلَهُ” (*ghaffalahu*) or “تَغْفِيلًا” (*taghfeela*): covered it, or hid it, or put a curtain over it, neglected it {T}. These are its basic meanings.

“أَغْفَلَهُ” (*aghfalahu*): made him careless about something.

The Quran says:

50:22	you were unaware of it so we lifted the curtains of unawareness	لَقَدْ كُنْتَ فِي غَفْلَةٍ مِنْ هَذَا فَكَشَفْنَا عَنْكَ غِطَاءَكَ
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“غَفَّلَهُ” (*ghaflatun*): to leave something and forget it.

Raghib says “غفلت” (*ghaflat*) or carelessness is the mistake which occurs due to lack of care and protection {T}.

Actually this means to become careless or unmindful of somebody or of some matter of importance.

“الْغَفُولُ” (*al-ghafool*): a camel whose is careless about its milk being taken by someone {T}.

“الْغَفْلُ” (*al-ghafil*): a man who can neither do well nor is there any fear of him doing badly.

It also means an arrow on which there is no sign. In a game of chance there is no share for such an arrow i.e. it neither does good or bad. It also means a road, on which there are no milestones, or a land which is uninhabited, or any animal which has no sign of ownership, or a man who has no line of descent. It also means a verse which has been said by an unknown poet {T}.

These meanings bring forth the right meaning of this root which is for something to have been neglected.

Ibn Faris says this word means to leave someone due to forgetfulness, but sometimes also means to leave someone deliberately.

But the Quran has used this word to mean unawareness and unfamiliarity in which there is no element of critique.

Surah *Yusuf* says that We tell you the story of *Yusuf* through the revelation:

12:3	although you were not aware of this before	وَإِنْ كُنْتَ مِنْ قَبْلِهِ لَمَنِ الْغَافِلِينَ
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In the same way the Quran says at many places:

2:74	Allah is not unaware of your deeds	وَمَا اللَّهُ بِغَافِلٍ عَمَّا تَعْمَلُونَ
24:23	The chaste, unaware and believing women	الْمُحْصَنَاتِ الْغُفْلَاتِ الْمُؤْمِنَاتِ

This has come for those chaste women who are not even aware about any talk of a bad character.

“غَافِلٌ” (*ghafilun*) is a verb of noun “غَفَلَ” (*ghafal*).

Surah *Al-Ambiya* says about the deniers that they will say:

21:97	we were careless or unaware about it	قَدْ كُنَّا فِي غَفْلَةٍ مِنْ هَذَا
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This means that the thing which they should have kept in mind was forgotten by them.

The dictionaries also say that “غَفْلَةٌ” (*ghafila'tun*) means this very thing.

Gh-L-B غ ل ب

“غَلَبَةُ” (*ghala'bat*) actually means to hold someone by the thick part of the neck {R}.

“غَلَبَ” (*ghaliba*), “يَغْلِبُ” (*yaghlabu*): a man with a small, fat neck bent to one side.

“نَاقَةُ غَلْبَاءُ” (*naaqatun ghalba'o*): a camel with a fat neck {T}. From this “غَلَبَةُ” (*ghalabat*) came to mean anger and upper hand, to seize someone or to defeat someone. This word is the noun of “غَلَبَ” (*ghalab*).

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:21	The people who took charge of or overwhelmed their affairs	الَّذِينَ غَلَبُوا عَلَىٰ أَمْرِهِمْ
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Surah *Ar-Rome* says:

30:3	after being overwhelmed	مِنْ بَعْدِ غَلَبِهِمْ
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“مَغْلُوبٌ” (*maghluboon*): on which another is overwhelming (54:10).

“الْغَلْبَاءُ” (*ghalba'o*): a thick garden {T}. The plural is “غُلْبٌ” (*ghulboon*).

80:30	thick gardens	وَحَدَائِقَ غُلْبًا
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Gh-L-Ze غ ل ظ

“الْغُلْظَةُ” (*al-ghilzatu*), “الْغَلْظَةُ” (*al-ghalzatu*), “الْغُلْظَةُ” (*al-ghulzatu*): fatness, harshness, intensity.

“أَغْلَظَ الثَّوْبُ” (*aghlazamn naub*): he found the cloth to be thick {R}.

“غَلِظَ” (*ghaleez*): compound, i.e. a thing whose components are much lesser in quantity hence harsh.

“الْغَلْظُ” (*al-ghalzu*): hard and uneven land, i.e. land which is hard but not stony. From here the word started meaning harshness and roughness {R}.

The Quran says that the group of believers should be strong and their harshness should be felt by their enemy (9:123), but their attitude must not be impolite. They must not be “غَلِظَ الْقَلْبُ” (*ghalizul qalb*) (3:158), i.e. they should be firm and strong and solid against their opponents and should intensely stop them (9:73). Their actions should reflect the laws of Allah which are “غِلَظُ شِدَادٍ” (*ghilazun shidaad*) i.e. impartial and harsh when they formulate the natural consequences of human deeds (66:9).

“اسْتَغْلَظَ” (*istaghlaz*): for something to become thick and strong. This happens generally when something has reached the peak of its development. Actually this word is spoken when the grains of wheat become thick and strong in their ear of corn {T}.

The Quran says about the purity of Islam that it is “فَاسْتَغْلَظَ” (*fastaghlaz*), that is, it is thick and strong (48:29).

“الْغِلَافُ” (*al-ghilaafu*): protector; the thing which overwhelms the other; for example the shell of an egg, the cover of a bud. The plural is “غُلْفٌ” (*ghulf*) or “غُلُفٌ” (*ghuluf*).
 “سَيْفٌ أَغْلَفُ” (*saifun aghluf*): the sword which is in its sheath.
 “الْغُلْفُ” (*al-ghalafu*): vegetables in abundance {T}.

The Quran has related one saying of the Jews:

2:88	their hearts are enclosed in covers	قَالُوا قُلُوبُنَا غُلْفٌ
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Here there plural form of “أَغْلَفُ” (*aghlaaf*) has been used.

Raghib says this means that their hearts are enclosed in covers and that is why they are not affected by the words of the Quran. Some say that their hearts and minds are already full to the brim with knowledge of all kinds and therefore there is no room for any further knowledge. This means that they do not have any room for the new invitation to embrace Islam. They do not need it, i.e. instead of deciding about the invitation through careful deliberation it is said without preamble that new invitation is not required! Obviously such behavior can never be appreciated by those who have insight, vision based on the Quranic knowledge, wisdom, and truth.

“أَغْلَقَ الْبَابَ” (*aghlaqal baaba*), “يُغْلِقُهُ” (*yughliquhu*): he closed the door.
 “بَابٌ غُلُقٌ” (*babun ghuluq*): closed door {T, R}.

Surah **Yusuf** says about the wife of the high official:

12:23	And the doors were closed	وَعَلَقَتِ الْأَبْوَابَ
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Raghib says “غَلَقَ” (*ghallaqa*) is said when a lot of doors have been closed; or a single door has been closed repeatedly; or the door has been closed very firmly.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning is for one thing to get stuck in another.

“غَلَّ” (*ghaflal*): for something to go into the middle spaces.
 “غَلَّ” (*ghulal*): the water that flows between the trees.
 “الْغَلُّ” (*al-ghallu*): the thing with which somebody is imprisoned because this way the prisoner’s body parts come within its confines. Its plural is “أَغْلَالٌ” (*aghlaal*) as in (7:157).
 “غَلَّ” (*ghulla*): imprisoned him with the help of a bath {R}.
 “مَغْلُولٌ” (*maghluul*): tied or imprisoned {R} (5:64).
 “الْغِلُّ” (*al-ghillu*): the enmity hidden in the heart (59:10). It also means deceit which is carried out secretly, i.e. the element of hiding it is predominant in the meaning.

“لَا يَذُوبُ كَلَامُنَا غَلَالًا” (*la yazhub kalamuna ghalala*): our stuff must not remain hidden from the people {T}.

Ibn Faris says this root basically means for something to pass between other things and to stay put.

“غَلَّ يَغْلِي” (*ghalla yughillu*): to nurture enmity in the heart.
 “غَلَّ يَغْلِي” (*ghalla yaghullu*): to misappropriate {R}.

Surah **Aal-e-Imran** says:

3:160	And it is not for a messenger to defraud	وَمَا كَانَ لِنَبِيٍّ أَنْ يَغْلُ
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It is generally translated as noted above; however, it is beneath a messenger to misappropriate. The author of *Al-minaar* says that it does not mean to misappropriate, but means not to misappropriate in the revelation i.e. not to withhold some part of the message. Here some explainers say that “غُلُوْلٌ” (*ghuduul*) means the same as “كَيْتْمَانٌ” (*kitmanoon*) or to hide. In short the main work of a messenger is to take Allah’s message to the people so that they can live according to it. He should transmit everything that is sent through him without any alteration or aberration. Now if there is anything in the message that goes against someone then the messenger is not responsible for it because he is simply Allah’s messenger and cannot hide some portion of the revelation just because it might offend someone. He transmits every part of the revelation to the people and he can’t make any change in it at his own (10:15).

It is said about the messenger **Muhammed**:

7:157	He shall unburden humans of any false conceptions or myths that had been burdening them for centuries	يَضَعُ عَنْهُمْ إِصْرَهُمْ وَالْأَغْلَالَ الَّتِي كَانَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ
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In other words, He will help remove the superstitions which humans had burdened themselves with and help break the shackles in which humanity was laboring under these beliefs and inner chains. He shall free humans of all bodily, and conceptual bondages and help bring them towards obeying the laws of Allah and thus grant them real freedom.

We can see how lofty the purpose of sending the messenger was and how beautifully the messenger **Muhammed** delivered it to humanity for all times to come i.e. not only the message in words but also by serving as a model through his conduct. But after that the following generations have gradually gathered together every link of the chain that the Quran had helped to break and presently wear all those bondages of wrong beliefs, concepts, assumptions, and superstitions with reverence around their ‘necks’!

Gh-L-M غ ل م

- “الْغُلْمَةُ” (*al-ghulmatu*): the intensity of sexual urge.
 “قَدْ غَلِمَ الرَّجُلُ” (*qad ghalimar rajul*): is said when a man becomes overwhelmed with sexual urge.
 “أَغْلَمَ الْبَحْرُ” (*aghlamal bahru*): the river became rough and began to be turbulent {T}.
 “إِغْتَلَمَ الشَّرَابُ” (*ightalamash-sharab*): the drink got stiff.
 “الْغُلَامُ” (*al-ghulam*): a boy who hits puberty

Taj-ul-Uroos says that a boy is referred to as “غُلَامٌ” (*ghulam*) from his birth to age of maturity. Sometimes the old call their progeny who may be middle aged as “غُلَامٌ” (*ghulam*) too.

Fiqah-ul-Lugha says that although a boy from his birth to his mature age is referred with many words, “غُلَامٌ” (*ghulam*) is the overall term for this entire period.

The Quran has used this word to mean son (3:39) as well as a young man (18:80). The word “غُلَامَانٌ” (*ghilmaan*) has appeared to mean servant boys in (52:25). It is possible that it means the sons in heaven or *jannat* because the wives and children are also supposed to be with those that dwell in heaven provided that they too deserve it (13:23). Please consult the heading (**J-N-N**) to understand the concept of *jannah*.

The real meaning of “غُلُو” (*ghulu*) is to exceed a limit. If this excess is in terms of things then it is called “غُلُو” (*ghala'o*). If the exaggeration is with regard to dignity and respect then it is called “غُلُو” (*ghuluwwa*), but if it is in regard to the distance an arrow travels, then it is called “غُلُو” (*ghalwu*).
 “الْمِغْلَى” (*al-mighla*): to shoot an arrow by stringing the bow taut so that the arrow goes beyond its limit.
 “الْغُلْوَةُ” (*al-ghilwah*): is the extreme limit to which an arrow can be shot {M}.
 “الْغَلْيَانُ” (*al-ghalayan*): for a pot to come to boil {M}.
 “إِغْتَالَى الْبَعِيرُ” (*ightalal bayeer*): a camel walked fast and held itself tall till it exceeded a balanced speed {T}.

The Quran says:

44:45	it will boil in the stomach like boiling water	يَغْلَى فِي الْبُطُونِ كَغَلْيِ الْحَمِيمِ
4:171	..do not exceed the laid down limits in <i>Deen</i> (the way of life defined by the Quran)...	لَا تَغْلُوا فِي دِينِكُمْ

This is what *husn* or balance means. See heading (*H-S-N*). Balance is disturbed both by addition and subtraction in a defined system. As such, if there is exaggeration in *Deen* then its purpose is defeated. That is why it is said at another place:

7:180	leave those who exaggerate on any one Attribute of Allah, because Allah is the owner of <i>asma'ul husna</i> (all balanced Attributes which serve as a model for the believers)	وَذَرُوا الَّذِينَ يُلْحِدُونَ فِي أَسْمَائِهِ
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This means that there is complete balance in all these Attributes, so no addition or subtraction is permitted in them as we cannot get the defined benefits in the life. There is no exaggeration or “غُلُو” (*ghulu*) whether in beliefs or deeds. At another place it has been forbidden to go any one way (in excess) in taking Allah's signs to keep everything in its proper place (41: 40). To value everything and to create a balance in everything and maintain that balance is the way to the balanced path. This can only be achieved by following the Quran.

“الْغَمْرَةُ” (*al-ghamrah*): a thing which overwhelms something and covers it completely.

Ibn Faris says that in this covering or hiding there should be an element of harshness and intensity. The Arabs used to put apportion water if it was short in supply and for this purpose put a stone into a cup of water and considered the amount of water that covered the stone as one portion to be distributed to each person. This water was called “غَمْرَةُ” (*ghamrah*) {T}, and the cup “الْغَمْرُ” (*al-ghumar*) {T}. Then abundant water also came to be known as “غَمْرَةُ” (*ghamrah*) {T} because it hides or covers whatever enters it.
 “مَوْتُ الْغَمْرِ” (*mautu ghamir*): to die by drowning {T}.
 “غَمَرَاتٌ” (*ghamaraat*): difficulties and miseries {R}.
 “غَمْرَةُ الشَّيْءِ” (*ghamaraatil maut*): Intensity of something and its overwhelming nature. (6:94).

Surah *Al-Mominoon* says:

23:54	Leave them in their confused ignorance for a time (i.e. Time will come when everything will be set right)	فَذَرُهُمْ فِي غَمَرَتِهِمْ حَتَّىٰ حِينٍ
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Raghib says “غَمْرَةُ” (*ghamrah*) here means unawareness and ignorance that swamps a person.

“غَمَزَ” (*ghamz*): to wink and point to a thing while speaking ill of it {R}.

“غَمَزَ الْكَبْشَ” (*ghamzal kabsh*): he squeezed a sheep to find out whether it is plump or not {R}.

Muheet says “غَمَزَ” (*ghamzun*) also means to prick, squeeze, and to press.

“الْتَّغَامُزُ” (*at-taghaamuz*): point to the weak points of someone by hand or eyes {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to nudge at something. Later it came to be used to mean “to speak ill of someone”.

The Quran says:

83:30	when they passed by them, they used to wink at each other and be sarcastic	إِذَا مَرُّوا بِهِمْ يَتَغَامَزُونَ
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“الْغَامِضُ” (*al-ghaamiz*): very low land.

“أَغْمَضَ النَّظَرَ” (*asghmazan nazar*): he used deep insight {R}.

“قَدْ أَغْمَضَ النَّظَرَ” (*qad aghmazan nazar*) is used when somebody gives a good opinion.

“الْغُمُضُ” (*al-ghumz*): a sleepy nod.

Ibn Faris says it means slope and to enter inside. He says that this is a nod in which eyes become closed.

“غَمَضَ عَيْنَهُ” (*ghamaza ainahu*), “أَغْمَضَهَا” (*aghmazaha*): he closed his eyes.

“إِغْمَازٌ” (*ighmaaz*): to give time, to be soft and to overlook.

“الْفُغْمِيزُ عَنِ الْإِسَاءِ” (*al-igmaazu fil bai*): not to ask for reduction in price when buying a thing just because it is faulty {T, R}.

The Quran says:

2:267	Do not give such bogus things in the name of Allah's charity which you wouldn't accept yourself	الْإِعْمَاضُ فِي الْبَيْعِ
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And if indeed the need to take them arises, then you would reduce their price due to their faults.

“غَمَّ الشَّيْءُ غَمًّا” (*ghammash shaiya ghamma*): covered it, hid it. These are its basic meanings.

“غَمَّ الْهَيْلَالُ” (*ghummal hilaal*): the moon came under clouds and could not be seen.

“الْغَمَامَةُ” (*al-ghamama*): white clouds. The plural is “غَمَامٌ” (*ghamaam*) (2:57).

“أَغَمَّتِ السَّمَاءُ” (*aghammati sama*): the sky became clouded.

“الْغِمَامَةُ” (*al-ghimaama*): the muzzle that is used for a camel so that it cannot eat. It also means a piece of cloth which is used for blindfolding a camel.

“الْغُمَّى” (*al-ghumma*): such difficult problems which are difficult for a man to get out of, or the misery out of which there seems to be no escape.

“الْغَمَّى” (*al-ghamma*): dust and darkness, war fever that engulfs a nation.

“الْغَمُّ” (*al-ghammu*): sadness and plight which encompass a man from all sides.

In surah *Aal-e-Imraan* this word has come opposite to “أَمَنَةٌ” (*aamanah*) or peace (3:153).

“الْغُمَّةُ” (*al-ghummah*): surprise. It also means darkness and constriction {T, M}.

Surah *Yunus* says:

10:71	So that your matter is not dubious or surprising for you	لَا يَكُنْ أَمْرُكُمْ عَلَيْكُمْ غُمَّةً
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Gh-N-M غ ن م

“الْغَنَمُ” (*al-ghanam*): goats. The singular is “شَاةٌ” (*shah*) which is not derived from this root.

Muheet says that this word can be used for both sheep and goats as in (20:18){*T, M*}.

“الْغَنِيمُ” (*al-ghaneem*), “الْغَنِيمَةُ” (*al-ghanaimah*), “الْغَنَمُ” (*al-ghunm*): war booty {*T*}.

Since in Arabic society domestic animals were considered big wealth, war booty also consisted mainly of these. So this came to be called “غَنِيمَةٌ” (*ghanimah*).

“غَنِمَ” (*ghanim*): to get something as a war booty, or to acquire something without laboring for it {*T*}.

“أَنَمَّا غَنِمْتُمْ” (*annama ghanimtum*), “الْمَغْنَمُ” (*al-maghnām*): booty. Plural is “مَغَانِمٌ” (*maghaanim*) as in (4:94).

Also see heading (*F-Y-A*) and (*N-F-L*).

Gh-N-Y غ ن ي

“الْغِنَى” (*al-ghina*): to be free of needs, to be strong and independent, to be content. It is the opposite of deprivation. If a man has no further needs then he is called “غَنِيٌّ” (*ghani*) (2:263, 4:6).

Ibn Faris says it basically means to have enough.

“الْغَانِيَّةُ” (*al-ghaaniyah*): a woman who is beautiful enough not to need any external adornment {*T*}.

49:6	God does not need the obedience of men	إِنَّ لَّغِنًى عَنِ الْعَالَمِينَ
93:8	their obedience is for their own good	أَغْنَىٰ عَنْهُ

“غَنَاءُ فُلَانٍ” (*ghana'a fulaan*): replaced him, worked like him.

“أَغْنَىٰ عَنْهُ كَذَا” (*aghna unhu kaaza*): that thing was enough for him, or that he was benefitted by that thing.

The Quran says:

111:2	his wealth did him no good	مَا أَغْنَىٰ عَنْهُ مَالُهُ
19:42	which can be of no use to you	لَا يُغْنِي عَنْكَ شَيْئًا
53:28	Verily falsehood does no good against the truth	إِنَّ الظَّلَّ لَا يُغْنِي مِنَ الْحَقِّ شَيْئًا
80:37	that day everyone will be so engaged in his work that it will be enough to grab his entire attention	لِكُلِّ امْرِئٍ مِنْهُمْ يَوْمَئِذٍ شَأْنٌ يُغْنِيهِ

“الْمُغْنَى” (*al-mughni*): he who looks after others' needs and benefits. The plural is “مُغْنُونَ” (*mughnoon*).

Surah *Ibrahim* says that when the followers see the punishment, they will say to their leaders:

14:21	Can you help us against Allah's punishment?	فَهَلْ أَنْتُمْ مُّغْنُونَ عَنَّا مِنْ عَذَابِ اللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ
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“أَغْنَىٰ عَنْهُ كَذَا” (*aghna unhu kaza*): removed it from him {*M*}.

“إِسْتَغْنَىٰ” (*istaghna*): to be free of needs (96:7, 80:5).

“غَنَىٰ بِالْمَكَانِ وَفِيهِ” (*ghania bil makaani wa feeh*): he stayed there for a long time.

“كَأَن لَّمْ يَغْنَوْا فِيهَا” (*ka-ul lum yaghnaufiha*): as if they had never lived in those houses (11:68, 7:92). It also means to stay somewhere for a longer period of time, but also to live a happy life.

“الْغَنَاءُ” (*al-ghana'u*): to take someone's place with full ability to work like him.

“الْغِنَاءُ” (*al-ghina-i*): a song.

“الْعَوْتُ” (*al-ghausu*), “الْغِيَاثُ” (*al-ghiyas*): help or assistance.
 “اسْتَغَاثَنِي فَلَانٌ فَأَعْنَتُهُ” (*istaghaasani falanun fa aghastu*): that man called for help so I helped him.
 “الْإِسْتَغَاثَا” (*al-istaghaasa*): to call for help or demand help {T}.
 “إِذْ تَسْتَغِيثُونَ رَبَّكُمْ” (*istastaghisoon rabbakum*): when you used to call your Sustainer for help (8:9).

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:29	..and if they call for help, then they shall be granted water like melted brass... (consequences linked to deeds)	وَإِنْ يَسْتَعِينُوا يَغَاثُوا بِمَاءٍ كَالْمُهْلِ
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Raghib says that it can be from “عَوْتُ” (*ghaus*) as well, i.e. to ask for help and from “غَيْثٌ” (*ghais*) too i.e. to ask for water.

“يَغَاثُوا” (*yughasu*) may also have two meanings {R}. See heading (*Gh-Y-T*).

“الْعَوْرُ” (*al-ghaur*): the depth of anything, or distance.
 “رَجُلٌ بَعِيدُ الْعَوْرِ” (*rajulun ba-eedul ghaur*): a man with deep understanding who possesses a lot of experience and knowledge.
 “الْعَوْرُ” (*al-ghaur*), “الْعِيَارُ” (*al-ghiyaar*): to enter into something. For water to permeate into the ground and become inaccessible {T, *Kitab-ul-Ashfaq*}.

The Quran says:

27:30	If your water level drops too low (and does not come up to the required level), then what can you do	إِنْ أَصْبَحَ مَاؤُكُمْ غَوْرًا
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“الْعَارُ” (*al-ghaar*): cave (9:40).
 “الْمَغَارَةُ” (*al-maghaarah*): cave. The plural is “مَغَارَاتُ” (*maghaaraat*) as in (9:57).
 “أَغَارَ” (*aaghaaz*): to be speedy.
 “فَرَسٌ مَغْوَارٌ” (*farsun mighwarun*): a very fast horse.
 “الْغَارَةُ” (*al-gharah*): a regiment of attackers, as well as an attack.
 “أَغَارَ عَلَى الْقَوْمِ” (*aghara al-qaoum*): attacked a nation {T}.

The Quran says:

100:3	horses for attacking and entering the ranks of the enemy	فَالْمَغِيرَاتِ صَبْحًا
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Ibn Faris says this root basically means depth as well as to take steps for taking someone's money by force.

“الْعَوَّصُ” (*al-ghaus*), “الْمَغَاصُ” (*al-maghaas*): to go under water, to dive.
 “الْمَغَاصُ” (*al-maghaas*): the diving place.
 “الْعَوَّاصُ” (*al-ghawwaas*): a diver {T, M}.

The Quran says about the story of **Suleman**:

21:92	the rebellious tribe who had been made faithful by Suleman used to dive for him	وَمِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ مَنْ يَغْوِصُونَ لَهُ
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At another place, in verse (38:37), they are the ones whom the Quran calls “عَوَّاصُ” (*ghawwaas*). It can also mean that they brazenly entered any escapade.

“غَائِصٌ” (*gha'is*): a man who gets to the bottom of a complicated case and solves the matter.

The basic meaning of this root is to proceed towards the core of basics of something and hence is used for entering.

Gh-W-Te غ و ط

“الْعَوْطُ” (*al-ghaut*), “الْغَايُطُ” (*al-gha'it*): low lying vast land. Since the Arabs used to go for defecation at a low place, therefore low also came to be called “غَايُطُ” (*ghaa-it*). They also used to dispose off such refuse in low lying areas, so human feces came to be called “غَايُطُ” (*ghaa-it*) as well. In verse (4:43) it means to be relieved.

“غَاطُ” (*ghaat*), “يَغُوطُ” (*yaghut*): to enter, or to go inside.

“الْعَوْطُ” (*al-ghaut*): to dig {F, T}.

“بِئْرٌ غَوِيْطَةٌ” (*beirun gha-italah*): deep well {T}.

Gh-W-L غ و ل

“غَالٌ” (*ghaal*): to arrest somebody when he is not expecting it or to catch someone by deceiving him.

“الْعَوْلُ” (*al-ghaul*): the distance of a ground or desert, because a traveler here may be killed anonymously and nobody may be aware of it {*Ibn Faris*}.

“الْعَوْلُ” (*al-ghaul*): also mean misery or annihilation.

“غَالَتْهُ غَوْلٌ” (*gha-iyhu ghaul*): annihilation destroyed him.

“غَالِ الشَّيْءُ” (*ghaalash shaiyi*): he destroyed that thing.

“الْعَوْلُ” (*al-ghaul*): headache, stupor, anything which compromises the intellect.

“الْعَوَائِلُ” (*al-ghawa-il*): destruction, misery.

“غَوْلٌ” (*ghul*): name of an Arabic ghost. It also means a serpent.

The Quran says about the “drink” of heaven:

37:47	It will not have any misery	لَا فِيْهَا عَوْلٌ
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Gh-W-Y غ و ي

“غَوَى” (*ghawa*), “غَيَا” (*ghaiyya*): to lose the way, to be deceived {T, M, R}.

“غَيَا” (*ghaiyya*) has appeared against “رُشْدٌ” (*rushd*) i.e. guidance.

2:256	The right and wrong paths clearly became separated	قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ الرُّشْدُ مِنَ الْغَيِّ
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It also means deceived:

53:2	your friend or companion is neither searching for the truth nor has he been deceived	مَا ضَلَّ صَاحِبُكُمْ وَمَا غَوَى
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It also means to suffer:

20:121	And Adam disobeyed his Sustainer and erred.	وَعَصَى آدَمُ رَبَّهُ فَغَوَى
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Raghib and *Lissan-ul-Arab* says that this verse means the same as “فَسَدَ عَيْشُهُ” (*fasada eeshuhu*), that is, for the economy to be constricted, or for earning for living to become a problem.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings:

- 1) Not to have guidance to the right path or for the matter to be bleak.
- 2) For something to be in chaos.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:59	Therefore soon they will meet destruction	فَسَوْفَ يَلْقَوْنَ غَيًّا
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Here **Raghib** says that “غَيَّ” (*ghaiyya*) means punishment or destruction {*T, R*}.

Taj and **Raghib** both say that it means to bring destruction upon yourself because of your own deeds.

“غَوِيٌّ” (*ghawwiyyun*): wrong way {*T, R*} (28:18).

“غَاوٍ” (*ghaawin*): he who is destroyed. Plural is “غَاوُونَ” (*ghaawoon*) meaning those who go astray {*T, R*} (26:94).

“اَغْوَى” (*aghwa*): to mislead.

Surah **Hood** says:

11:34	to be destroyed as a consequence of bad deeds { <i>T, R</i> }	يُرِيدُ أَنْ يُغْوِيَكُمْ
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“الْغَوَى” (*al-ghawa*): indigestion, thirst.

“الْغَاوِي” (*al-ghaawi*): swarm of insects {*T, R*}.

Surah **Ash-Shura** says:

26:224	those who follow the poets are deceived	وَالشُّعْرَاءُ يَتَّبِعُهُمُ الْغَاوُونَ
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This is because as it has been explained under the heading (**Sh-Ain-R**) that poetry is based on emotions and not based on facts. Therefore those who follow these emotive utterances and take these as facts, indeed misguide themselves away from the realities of life. It could also mean that their thirst can never be quenched because thirst for knowledge can only be quenched by facts not by aroused emotions. Therefore the poets themselves have been called “يَهِيمُونَ” (*yahimoon*) in (26:225), that is, those who wander hither and thither like a thirsty camel. See heading (**He-Y-M**). It could also mean that poets themselves are deceived or taken in by their followers and fans. They think that their fans are really their followers whilst they are like a swarm and an unthinking crowd only. Millions to look at but without any fixed destiny or purpose of life. The ultimate result of all of them is destruction as they wasted time in this life which is the basis for the next life. If it is looked at with regard to the word meaning “indigestion” then it would mean that the condition of the followers of poets is that whatever thinking they receive is ultimately lost because it is not a part of their own thought process. They only get some words which provide mental entertainment for a while and then become the cause of destruction as noted earlier.

“الْغَيَاةُ” (*al-ghayayah*): dust storm and the darkness it causes.

“الْغَايَةُ” (*al-ghayah*): a flag, because it casts a sort of shade on people.

“غَايَةً” (*ghayah*): the extreme of something, because a flag is a sign of the ultimate existence of an army, according to **Ibn Faris**.

“غَوَى الْفَصِيلُ” (*ghawiyal fasilu*), “غَوَى” (*ghawayah*), “غَوَايَةً” (*ghawayatan*), “غَوَى” (*ghawa*): the little camel took a lot of milk and he had indigestion and his stomach was upset {*T*}. This too indicates the destruction to which the “مُتْرَفِينَ” (*mutrafeen*) fall prey. Conversely “غَوَى الْجَدْيُ” (*ghuwiyal jadiyu*) means that a kid was stopped from getting to the milk due to which it became lean and went near death {*T*}. This too manifests the destruction which befalls due to the natural consequences. Also see heading (**Ain-Dh-B**).

One thing is common between all the words of this root used by the Quran. They will indicate man following his desires instead of the laws of Allah, and leaning the other way while giving up the right path. Hence it basically means to go astray, and be deceived. This basic meaning encompasses all.

- “غَيْبٌ” (*ghaib*): anything that is out of sight is. It also means a concept which is not visible.
 “غَابَةٌ” (*ghabat*): low land or low land preceded by high land and thus hidden to the eyes.
 “غَابَةٌ” (*ghabah*): dense forest in which you cannot see the land due to thick trees.
 “غِيَابَةٌ” (*ghayabah*): anything which is hidden from view, like a ditch or a well (12:10).
 “غَيِّبَاتُ الشَّجَرِ” (*ghayyibaat ush-shajar*): the roots of a tree which are underground and cannot be seen {M}.

The Quran has used the word “شَهَادَةٌ” (*shahadat*) against “غَائِبٌ” (*ghaib*) in (59:22) and thus expostulated this word’s meaning.

- “غَيْبٌ” (*ghaayib*) is something which cannot be seen, or which is not manifest.
 “فَرَسٌ غَائِبٌ” (*farsun ghaayib*): a horse which reserves some strength in a race.
 “فَرَسٌ شَاهِدٌ” (*farsun shahid*): a horse which uses up all its force {L}.

For something to be “غَيْبٌ” (*ghaib*) it must be present somewhere but oblivious to the eyes. When something which is “غَائِبٌ” (*gha-ib*) becomes visible it becomes “شَهَادَةٌ” (*shahadat*) or evident. If it does not exist at all, then that thing cannot be called “غَائِبٌ” (*ghaa-ib*).

- “غَيْبَةٌ” (*gheebah*): to discuss someone’s faults behind his back, because these faults are present in this person but unpleasant for him to hear about them. If that (bad trait) is not present in him at all then it is not “غَيْبَةٌ” (*gheebet*) but “تُهْمَةٌ” (*tuhmat*) or accusation {T}.
 “إِغْتَابٌ” (*ightaab*): to hide something so it is no longer visible (49:12).

The Quran has called God “عَالِمُ الْغَيْبِ” (*aalimul ghaib*) in (59:22). Therefore to have faith does not mean to have blind faith on “بِالْغَيْبِ” (*bil ghaib*), that is “on the unseen God”, but it also means to have faith on the results which start to be built along with a deed itself but manifest later. Similarly the happy results of good deeds are always present in the deeds, but as long as the system is not formulated, those results are not manifested. The group of *momineen* place faith in those unseen results, and they always try to establish that system. In this attempt they sacrifice in every way. If they had not believed on the unseen results of the system then they would not have raised a finger to establish that system. As such, to have faith in those unseen results is a precondition for establishing that system.

A farmer toils in all seasons only because he believes that the seeds he is sowing will one day bring fruit or crop. If this belief is not there then he would not toil even a single day in the field. The group which at first tries to establish the Quranic system does not have the good results of the system before it, because the results are manifest only when the system is established. They continue to sacrifice for this system only because they believe that this system will be fruitful. This is what “إِيمَانٌ بِالْغَيْبِ” (*eeman bil ghaib*) or “belief on the unseen Allah or His system” is. Secondly “الْغَيْبُ” (*al-ghaib*) means all those things which are beyond the physical horizon. In a way it also encompasses God’s personality as well.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:123	all those things in the universe which are currently oblivious to man but will be made manifest in the future	وَلِلَّهِ غَيْبُ السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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They have also been called “مَفَاتِيحُ الْغَيْبِ” (*mafaatihil ghaib*) in (6:59) and “غَائِبَةٌ” (*ghaaibah*) in (27:75). This word has been used to mean the future in (19:61) and to mean things of the past which were not known to the people:

3:43	This is the news of the unseen	ذَٰلِكَ مِنْ أَنْبَاءِ الْغَيْبِ
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Surah *Yusuf* says:

15:52	I have made no misappropriations behind him	لَمْ أَكُنْهُ بِالْغَيْبِ
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- “غِيَابَةٌ” (*ghayaabah*): depth of a well (12:10).

The Quran says that nobody except Allah knows about the “غيب” (*ghaib*):

27:65	Say, there is none in the Heavens and the Earth who has any knowledge about unseen (<i>ghaib</i>) but Allah	قُلْ لَا يَعْلَمُ مَنْ فِي السَّمٰوٰتِ وَالْاَرْضِ الْغَيْبَ اِلَّا اللّٰهُ
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Even a messenger does not know about the *ghaib*, although Allah does tell the messengers about some things of *ghaib* through the revelation.

11:31	do not know anything about <i>ghaib</i>	لَا اَعْلَمُ الْغَيْبَ
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Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:43	this is one of the things of <i>ghaib</i> which Allah has made known to you through the revelation	ذٰلِكَ مِنْ اَنْبَاءِ الْغَيْبِ نُوحِيْهِ اِلَيْكَ
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Since revelation is now completed in the Quran, therefore there is no question of any human being aware of anything of *ghaib*. We usually think that *ghaib* means the unseen events of the future still to happen, of even events expected after death. Claims made by people these days to possess such a knowledge is nothing more than a guess (18:22). Any guess work or shot in the dark which sometimes may even turn to be right. The hidden forces of nature can be found out about with scientific research. Until those forces are discovered they too will be *ghaib* since they are present, but not always visible, but when those things are discovered, these will become evident and consequently become *mash-hoodh*. But there are some things about which no human being can know about, for example, God’s personality or the life hereafter. Also see heading (*Sh-He-D*).

Gh-Y-T غ ي ث

“الْغَيْثُ” (*al-ghais*): rain which is very wide and very beneficial, or the grass which such rain give rise to.
 “غَاثَ اللّٰهُ الْبِلَادَ” (*ghaasal laahul bilaad*): Allah made it rain over these cities.
 “قَرَسُ دُوْعَيْثَ” (*qarasun ghees*): a horse which keeps increasing its speed.
 “بَيْرُ ذَاتِ غَيْثٍ” (*beyruun zaatun ghayyis*): the well which has a natural spring in it {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

31:34	Allah makes it rain	وَيُنَزِّلُ الْغَيْثَ
18:29	And if they call for relief	وَإِنْ يَسْتَعْجِنُوْا

Raghib says that it could have come from “غَوْثُ” (*ghausu*) which means to ask for help, or from “غَيْثُ” (*ghaisun*) which means to ask for a drink of water.
 That is why we have written it under the heading (*Gh-W-T*).

Gh-Y-R غ ي ر

“غَيْرَ” (*ghairun*) usually means “else”, “except” and “beside” {*T*}.
 “غَيَّرَ” (*ghayyara*): to change, to bring a change {*T*}.
 “تَغَيَّرَ” (*taghaiyara*): to get changed {*T*}.

7:59	there is no God for you except Allah	مَا لَكُمْ مِنْ اِلٰهِ غَيْرُهُ
13:1	God never alters a nation’s condition until.....	اِنَّ اللّٰهَ لَا يُغَيِّرُ مَا بِقَوْمٍ
47:15	whose taste does not change	لَمْ يَتَغَيَّرْ طَعْمُهُ

The Quran has related a principle about the rise and fall of a nation:

8:53	till a nation changes its psychology (i.e. inner self), there is no change in its own condition	اِنَّ اللّٰهَ لَا يُغَيِّرُ مَا بِقَوْمٍ حَتّٰى يُغَيِّرُوْا مَا بِاَنْفُسِهِمْ
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But this statement has a fine point. The Arabs used to travel by camel and used camels for transportation of goods as well, whether these goods were loaded on a camel's back or whether there was a *kajawah* (a sort of howdah) on the back which became slightly loose in travel. Sometimes the ropes with which these were tied needed repair. Therefore the Arabs while traveling always kept an eye open as to what needed to be repaired and wherever they felt the need for a camel to sit down so they could fasten any loose ropes. This they called “غَيْرَ عَنْ بَعِيرِهِ” (*ghaiyyara un ba-eerehi*). They took the *kajawah* off a camel's back, repaired it and then loaded it again on the camel.

“تَرَكَ الْقَوْمَ يُعَيِّرُونَ” (*tarakil qoma yaghayyiroon*): he left his people while they were repairing their *kajawas* so that everything was all right during travel {M}.

This is also true for nations. Nations that in their life's journey keep an eye on its goods (deeds and things) and adjusts accordingly, reaches its destination quite comfortably, but a nation which is oblivious to this, loose its “goods” during the journey.

A thing that is noteworthy here is that *Ibn Faris* says this root has two meanings basically:

- 1) Difference between two things
- 2) Reform and benefit.

“غَارَبُ اللَّهُ بِالْغَيْثِ” (*ghaara humullaah bil ghaisi*): Allah reformed their condition with rain.

“الْغَيْرَةُ” (*al-ghairah*): the goods or things with which a condition is reformed.

“إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُغَيِّرُ” (*annal laahu la yughayyiru...*): here the change will be for the better or for reform.

“غَارَ” (*ghaara*), “يَغَارُ” (*yughaar*): to be chagrined or embarrassed or affronted.

“غَيْرَةُ” (*ghairun*) is a noun from it. That is, when you own a thing and somebody else interferes in it, then you feel chagrined or affronted.

Gh-Y-Sd غ ي ض

“غَاضَ” (*ghaaz*), “يَغِيضُ” (*yagheez*), “غَيْضًا” (*ghaiza*): for something to be short or useless or to lessen.

“غَاضَ الْمَاءُ” (*ghaazal maa-u*): the water was absorbed or dried out.

“الْغَيْضُ” (*al-ghaiz*): any pregnancy that is aborted {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it means for something to decrease and sink to the bottom.

The Quran says:

13:8	By how much the wombs fall short or do exceed	مَا تَغِيضُ الْأَرْحَامُ وَ مَا تَزْدَادُ
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This might mean the children that are born before time or after time (of 9 months). It can also mean more than one child in the mother's womb e.g. twins.

Raghib says that “مَا تَغِيضُ الْأَرْحَامُ” (*ma tagheezul arhaam*) means those which the wombs distort and make useless.

Surah *Hoodh* says about the storm of *Nooh*:

11:4	the water decreased (or dried up)	وَغِيضَ الْمَاءُ
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“الْغَيْظُ” (*al-ghaiz*): wrath {T}.

Raghib says that “الْغَيْظُ” (*al-ghaizun*) means intense wrath, that is, the heat in which a man’s heartbeat increases {R}.

Some say that the initial rage or emotion is called “غَيْظٌ” (*ghaiz*), yet others think that “غَيْظٌ” (*ghaiz*) is hidden rage while “غَيْظٌ” (*ghazab*) is obvious rage, or that “غَيْظٌ” (*ghaza*) is the wrath of someone authoritative and “غَيْظٌ” (*ghaizun*) the wrath of a powerless man {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means the pain and trouble that a man faces because of another.

“غَاظَهُ” (*ghaazah*): made him angry, enraged him (22: 15).

“غَاظٌ” (*ghaa-iz*) is one who enrages someone. The plural is “غَاظُونَ” (*ghaa-izoon*) as in (26:55).

“التَّغْيِظُ” (*at-taghaiyyuz*): the display of rage which is sometimes expressed in a furious manner with a sound {R} (25:12).

“ف” (*fa*) produces the following meanings:

1) For a sequence, as in “then this happened”, “then that”, “then thither” etc. As in:

23:14	Later We turn the sperm into a lump, then turn the lump into a lump of flesh, then create bones in this lump of flesh, then put flesh on the bones	ثُمَّ خَلَقْنَا النُّطْفَةَ عَلَقَةً فَخَلَقْنَا الْعَلَقَةَ مُضْغَةً فَخَلَقْنَا الْمُضْغَةَ عِظَامًا فَكَسَوْنَا الْعِظَامَ لَحْمًا
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But it is not a rule that “ف” (*fa*) always comes for a sequence:

7:4	And there are many dwellings in which our punishment visited and We annihilated them. Our punishment came upon them when they were either sleeping or resting	وَكَمْ مِنْ قَرْيَةٍ أَهْلَكْنَاهَا فَجَاءَهَا بَأْسُنَا بَيِّنًا أَوْ هُمْ قَائِلُونَ
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2) To express timeliness, i.e. for an event to happen at the time it should happen:

“تَزَوَّجَ فَوُلِدَ” (*tazawwaja fawuldidalahu*): got married, **then** after the right time (nine months) a child was born. If a child was born after or earlier than nine months then “ف” (*fa*) will not be used.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:16	And relate the story of <i>Maryam</i> in the Quran when she parted from her people and went to a place towards the east.	وَأَذْكُرْ فِي الْكِتَابِ مَرْيَمَ إِذِ اتَّيَدَّتْ مِنْ أَهْلِهَا مَكَانًا شَرْقِيًّا
19:17	Then she drew herself into a curtain, so We sent our “ <i>rooh</i> ” towards her which went to her like a full-fledged man.	فَاتَّخَذَتْ مِنْ دُونِهِمْ حِجَابًا فَأَرْسَلْنَا إِلَيْهَا رُوحَنَا فَتَمَثَّلَ لَهَا بَشَرًا سَوِيًّا
19:22	Then Maryam conceived a child, then she went along with him to a far off place ...	فَحَمَلَتْهُ فَاتَّيَدَّتْ بِهِ مَكَانًا قَصِيًّا
19:23	Then labour-pains brought her near a date palm	فَأَجَاءَهَا الْمَخَاضُ إِلَى جُذْعِ النَّخْلَةِ
19:24	Then from beneath she heard a voice saying “do not be sad”.	فَنَادَاهَا مِنْ تَحْتِهَا

This does not mean that these events took place sequentially one after another at a regular interval continuously. This sequence means that these events happened one after another at the required time interval for such like event and once the first event was over, then the next one came along at the required time interval.

3) For one event to become the cause of another as “I slapped him which made him swoon”.

The Quran says:

28:15	Then <i>Moosa</i> hit him and he died	فَوَكَزَهُ مُوسَى فَقَضَى عَلَيْهِ
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4) To mean ‘and’:

2:36	so the <i>Shaitan</i> induced them from it, and thus was the cause of their exit from there	فَأَزَلَّهُمَا الشَّيْطَانُ عَنْهَا فَأَخْرَجَهُمَا مِمَّا كَانَا فِيهِ
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The “ف” (*fa*) in “فَأَخْرَجَ” (*faakhraj*) could signify the “means”.

5) If it appears after “if” then it means “therefore”:

3:30	if you love Allah then follow Me (<i>i.e. My Guidance</i>)	إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ فَاتَّبِعُونِي
3:114	and whatever good deed they perform, will not go unrecognized	وَمَا يَنْفَعُوكُمْ مِنْ خَيْرٍ فَلَنْ يُكْفَرُوهُ

6) Sometimes it is redundant:

39:66	Instead obey Allah.	بَلِ اللَّهَ فَاعْبُدْ
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7) Sometimes it is used to stress a swearing:

38:82	He said “by your overwhelm and authority”	قَالَ فَبِعِزَّتِكَ
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Here “فَ” (*fa*) is redundant, i.e. it has appeared only for continuity and hence has no meaning.

F-A-D ف ا د

“فَأَذَّ الْخُبْزُ بِفَأَدُهُ” (*faadal-khubza bifaaduhu*): heated bread in a fire.
 “فَأَذَّ اللَّحْمَ بِالنَّارِ” (*faadal-lahma binnaar*): to roast meat in a fire.
 “الْخُبْزُ الْمَفْعُودُ” (*al-khubzal-maghnood*): Bread that has been made in fire.
 “الْفَيْدُ” (*al-faidu*): fire {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means fever, intensity and temperature.

The Quran has used “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*) and “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) to mean the heart.
 “أَفِيدَةٌ” (*af-idah*): the plural form of “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) (6:111).

Raghib says that a heart is called “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) when it has a sense of beating.

Taj says that the actual meaning of “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) is to move and be moved.
 The heart is called “فَوَادٌ” (*fu-aad*) because it beats a lot. When emotions are in question then “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) will be used, and “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*) would be used when the mind is in reference.

“فَأَذَّ زَيْدًا” (*fada Zaid*): *Zaid's* heart.
 “فَأَذَّ الْخَوْفُ فَلَانًا” (*faadal-haufu fulana*): a man turned coward because of fear {T}. These things are related to emotions not thoughts.

But as mentioned above, this division of “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*) and “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) is not a rule. Both are used to mean the heart. In the Quran it must be seen with reference to context at which point intellect and thought are meant and at which point emotions are referred.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:36	Do not pursue (for finding out) something which you do not know. Remember that your eyesight, hearing and heart will all be questioned as to what they did	إِنَّ السَّمْعَ وَالْبَصَرَ وَالْفُؤَادَ كُلُّ أُولَئِكَ كَانَ عَنْهُ مَسْئُولًا
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Here sight and hearing are sense perceptions and “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) means both mind and emotions. The mind because it concludes whatever the senses have informed it about, and emotions because if the information provided by the senses is affected by emotions then man can never draw a right conclusion. This is why the Quran has laid stress on the use of both to develop conviction in the revelation. This means to evaluate and analyse the facts using the intellect and reasoning and to use emotions i.e. “فَوَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) to get it accomplished – this is all in reference to the Quranic Values (6:111-114).

Surah *Hoodh* says that the reference to the past messengers is quoted to:

11:120	We may strengthen your heart with these references	مَا نُنَبِّئُ بِهِ فُؤَادَكَ
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Surah *Al-Qasas* says that when *Moosa's* mother laid him down in a box and let him drift in the river:

28:10	her heart was bereft of patience	أَصْبَحَ فُؤَادُ أُمِّ مُوسَىٰ فَرَجًا
28:10	if we had not strengthened her heart then she would have revealed her tribulations	لَوْلَا أَن رَّبَطْنَا عَلَىٰ قَلْبِهَا

Also see heading (*Q-L-B*).

“الْفَيْءُ” (*al-fe’atah*): a group or a party whose members approach each other for co-operation. It also means reserve battalion which can be depended upon to defend if needed {*T, M*} (8:16).
 “إِنْفِيَاءٌ” (*infia-un*): to open {*T, M*}.

“مَا أَفْنَأَيْعَلُ كَذَا” (*ma’afna’a yaf alu kaza*), “مَا فَتَى” (*mafatia*), “مَا فَتَى” (*ma’fata*), “مَا فَتَى” (*mafatia*): he continued performing that task, or always kept on doing it.
 “فَتَى عَنِ الْأَمْرِ” (*fatia inil amr*): he abstained from it.

Scholars say that “فَتَى” (*fatia*) always follow something negative in a sentence {*T, M, R*}. Hence where the Quran says “تَاللّٰهِ تَفْتَأُ تَذْكُرُ يُوسُفُ” (*tallaahi taftahu tazkuru yusuf*) in (12:85), then before “تَفْتَأُ” (*taftawu*) the “لَا” (*la*) is silent. It actually means the same as “لَا تَفْتَأُ” (*la taftawu*) which means “you will never give up remembering *Yusuf*” or “you will never forget him”.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is continuity, i.e. to do something continuously.

“فَتَحَ” (*fatah*), “يَفْتَحُ” (*yafatah*), “فَتْحًا” (*fatha*): opened.
 “فَتَّاحٌ” (*fattah*): appears for intensity in opening.
 “إِنْفَتَحَ” (*infatah*): opened up {*T*}.
 “الْفَتْحُ” (*al-fath*): water flowing on the surface of land. It also means help, aid or to judge between two opponents in order to settle a dispute among them.
 “فَتَحَ الْحَاكِمُ بَيْنَهُمْ” (*fatahal-haakimu bainahum*): the ruler decided between them.
 “الْأَسْتِفْتَا” (*al-stiftaah*): wanted to have it opened, decided, overpowered, or to be helped (2:89).
 “الْمَفْتَاحُ” (*al-maftah*): treasure.
 “الْفَتْاحُ” (*al-fattah*): ruler, judge of big matters, someone who resolves difficult issues, one who exposes facts. It is one of the Attributes of Allah (34:26).
 “الْفَتْحُ” (*al-fath*): sustenance which God opens up for someone {*T*}.

The Quran says:

2:76	the things that Allah has made clear to you (the doors of which have been opened to you)	إِنَّمَا فَتَحَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْكُمْ
7:89	Our Sustainer, bring forth the last word or decision between us and our nation	رَبَّنَا افْتَحْ بَيْنَنَا وَبَيْنَ قَوْمِنَا
14:15	They asked for the last or final verdict	وَأَسْتَفْتِحُوا
32:29	The moment of decisive revolution	يَوْمَ الْفَتْحِ
28:76	(the treasures of <i>Qaroon</i> are)	مَفَاتِحُهَا
24:61	The overseer of whose goods or wealth you are (which you control)	أَوْ مَا مَلَكَتْهُم مِّفَاتُهَا

(35:2) uses this root against “إِمْسَاكٌ” (*imsaak*) or “to stop”.

Surah *Al-fath* says:

48:1	We have opened the path of living for you (or opened up the doors to knowledge for you)	إِنَّا فَتَحْنَا لَكَ فَتْحًا مُّبِينًا
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This verse could also mean that “We have endowed you with a clear and decisive revolution”, or “the paths of life have been opened up for you by removing any difficulties so that truths can be revealed”.
 Obstructions to disappear and decisive revolution to take place, is all “فَتْحٌ” (*fath*).

“فَتَّرَ” (*fatar*), “يَفْتُرُ” (*yaftur*), “فُتُّرًا” (*futura*): to be soft after being harsh, or to lessen in intensity.
 “فَتَّرَ الْمَاءَ” (*fataral-maa'u*): the water became less hot.
 “الْفَاتِرُ” (*al-faatir*): semi hot water.
 “فَتَّرَ جِسْمَهُ” (*fataral-jismah*): his bodily joints became weak.
 “طَرَفَ فَاتِرٌ” (*tarafun fatir*): weak sight.
 “أَفْتَرَشَ الشَّرَابَ” (*afatarash sharaab*): the drunk started losing his stupor and he began softening up {T}.
 “نَتَّرَ الْعَذَابَ” (*fattaral-azaab*): lessened the punishment or lightened its intensity (23:75).

Ibn Faris says it means for something to become weak.

Surah *Ambia* says about universal forces or the *malaikah*:

21:20	they are always dedicatedly engaged in carrying out their duties and they never slacken	يُسَبِّحُونَ اللَّيْلَ وَ النَّهَارَ لَا يَفْثُونَ
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About the messenger *Muhaammed* it is said that he made his advent:

5:19	when the influence of the past messengers of the Bani <i>Israeel</i> had become weak	عَلَى فَتْرَةٍ مِنَ الرُّسُلِ
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Before the time of the last messenger a messenger was required to reinvigorate the revelation and to invite people to the permanent values. However, as the time passed the revelation was forgotten and a new messenger was required to invite people to establish a system within the domain of the permanent values. The revelation itself got distorted as the human means and civilisation had not developed to the extent to preserve the message in its original text. At the time of the last messenger the means had developed where the message could be put together as a text in a book and then protected in its original form till the last day. The Quran as we know is in its original form, preserved and protected by Allah and the human intellect has developed to the extent where it can understand the message and can benefit by following it. The need now is to understand it and then follow it with a view to establish a system as a model so that it can serve as a specimen of righteousness for others.

“فَتَّقَهُ” (*fataqah*), “يَفْتِقُ” (*yaftiq*), “يَفْتُقُ” (*yaftuq*): he teared it up {T}.

“فَتَّقَ الثَّوْبَ” (*fataqas saub*): tore up the cloth and separated its pieces {T}.

“الْفَتْقُ” (*al-fatq*): to separate two things which are joined together, or for expansion and vastness to be created in something {F}.

The Quran says about the earth and the heavens:

21:30	First this whole universe (including the earth and the heavens) were one big ball as a single entity, but later different planets were created from this mass.	كَانَتَا رَتْقًا فَفَتَقْنَاهُمَا
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For details see (*R-T-Q*).

“فَتَّلَ” (*fatal*): winded the rope.

Ibn Faris says that winding something is the basic meaning of this root.

“الْفَتِيلُ” (*al-fateel*): the thin white membrane which is found in the gap between a seed of a date. It is used by the Arabs to signify something that is very little or insignificant {T}.

The Quran says:

4:49	not an iota will be reduced in the development of their personality (they will be rewarded in full)	وَلَا يُظْلَمُونَ فَتِيلًا
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Also see (17:71)

“فَتَنَ” (*fatan*) basically means to melt gold and silver so that their impurity can be removed.

“وَرَقٌ فَتِينٌ” (*wariqun fateen*): heated silver.

“دِينَارٌ مَقْطُونٌ” (*deenaroon maftoon*): a forged coin {T}. It also means to manifest the reality of something.

“الْفَتَانَةُ” (*al-fannaana*): the criteria (stone) on which gold and silver is rubbed to find out if they are real {M}.

“فِتْنَةٌ” (*fitnah*): to make someone angry to test him. It also means to burn.

“فَتَنَتِ النَّارُ الرَّغِيفَ” (*fatnabbin naarur ragheef*): the fire burned the bread.

“فِتْنَةٌ” (*fitna*) also means punishment, misery, and war too. It also means to lead astray {T}.

“فَتَنَهُ” (*fatnahu*), “أَفْتَنَهُ” (*aftanahu*): liked him.

10:85	Our Sustainer, make us not guinea pigs for those who practice oppression.	رَبَّنَا لَا تَجْعَلْنَا فِتْنَةً لِّلْقَوْمِ الظَّالِمِينَ
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If these people overpower us then they will believe that they are better than us. Therefore they will more strongly stick to their wrong beliefs {T}.

The Quran has used this root to mean war “فِتْنَةٌ” (*fitnih*) in (4:91), difficulties of war “يُفْتَنُونَ” (*yuftanun*) in (9:126) and to lead astray “بِفَاتِنِينَ” (*bifatineen*) in (37:162), as well as waywardness “فِتْنَةٌ” (*fitnah*) in (39:49). This will also be the meaning in (5:49) and (17:73) where this word means to lead astray.

“فِتْنَةٌ” (*fitnah*) has appeared against “خَيْرٌ” (*khair*) in (22:11), which means something good for all.

Surah *Taha* says about *Moosa*:

20:40	We brought you up by passing you through different challenges and thus made you befitting of messenger hood	وَفَتَّنَكَ فُتُونًا
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This means that “فِتْنَةٌ” (*fitnah*) also means to create such opportunities for a man as to bring forth his latent capabilities and the man comes to know as to what extent he has developed. “فِتْنَةٌ” (*fitnah*) is also for human civilization to not be in consonance with the laws of Allah. Overall this word has been used in the Quran to mean those obstructions which come in the way of following Allah’s laws (8:39, 2:193).

This word has also been used to mean pain and misery in (22:11).

It has also come to mean punishment in (37:63), and to mean deception and fraud in (2:102).

“الْمَقْطُونُ” (*al-maftoon*): defrauded and astray (68:6). It has also come to mean punishment in (6:35), and to mean apology and proof in (6:23).

“أَفْتَاءُ” (*al-fata-u*): youth, prime.

“أَفْتَى” (*al-fata*): young man. Later this word also came to mean slave, whether he be young or old or of any age.

“فَتَى” (*fatan*): slave man

“فَتَاةٌ” (*fataat*): slave woman {T, M}.

Meaning a young man “فَتَى” (*fatan*) has appeared in (21:60). The feminine is “فَتَيَانٌ” (*fatayaan*) as in (12:36). The plural is “فَتَيَّةٌ” (*fityah*) as in (18:80).

“فَتَيَانٌ” (*fityaan*) is also a plural (12:62). The plural of “فَتَاةٌ” (*fataat*) is “فَتَيَاتٌ” (*fatayaat*) as in (4:25).

Ibn Faris says that the root has two basic meanings:

- 1) Freshness and to be new. The meaning youth is derived from this.
- 2) To make a decision or an order evident and explained.

“أَفْتَى” (*aftaa*): to issue an order, to issue an edict, to answer a question. It is said to have been derived from the word “فَتَى” (*fatan*) i.e. youth who has freshness and strength {T, M}. This would mean that to issue an edict one must possess freshness and strength (of knowledge). It may also have been derived from “أَفْتُوهُ” (*al-futuwwah*) which means philanthropy {T, M}.

“أَفْتَى” (*aftaa*) also means to order.

“قُلْ اللَّهُ يُفْتِيكُمْ” (*qulil laahu yuftikum*): Say, Allah will answer you about the right decision (4:176)

“اسْتَغْفِرْنِي فَنَوَى” (*istafta*): to seek decision or edict (4:176).

“أَفْجَ” (*al-fajju*): vast gorge between two mountains. “فَجَاجٌ” (*fijaa*) is the plural form {T, M}.

The Quran says:

22:27	from every distant door or path	مِنْ كُلِّ فَجٍّ عَمِيقٍ
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“أَفْجَاجٌ” (*al-fujaaj*): distant path.

“أَفْجَجَ” (*al-fajju*): to increase the distance between two things.

“أَفْجَجَ” (*al-fujjah*): the distance between two mountains {T}.

The Quran says:

21:3	we created wide pathways between mountains	وَجَعَلْنَا فِيهَا فِجَاجًا
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“أَفْجَرُ” (*al-fajr*) actually means to tear asunder or tear apart: it also bears the connotation of leaning or moving to one side.

“فَجَّرَهُ” (*fajarahu*) or “يَفْجُرُهُ” (*yafjuruhu*): divided the water and made it flow.

“فَجَّرَهُ” (*fajjarahu*), “تَفْجِيرًا” (*tafjeerah*): divided the water and made it flow with force.

“أَفْجَرَ الْيَنْبُوعَ” (*afjaral-u-yanbu*): tore the spring apart and brought it out.

“إِنْفَجَرَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ الدَّوَابُّ” (*infajarat alihim ad dawahi*): misery accosted them from all sides.

“أَفْجَرُ” (*al-fajr*): the light of the morning which tears the darkness of the night asunder and appears.

“طَرِيقُ فَجْرٍ” (*tareequn fajarun*): clear path.

“أَفْجَارٌ” (*al-fijaar*): the paths: {T, M}

Ibn Faris says it basically means wideness and openness.

“فَجَرَ الرَّكِيبُ فُجُورًا” (*fajarar raakibu fujura*): the rider shifted to one side in his saddle.

“فَجَرَ عَنِ الْحَقِّ” (*fajaral-unil haqq*): he moved away from the truth {T, M}.
 “فَاسِقٌ وَفَاجِرٌ” (*faasiq faajir*) is said to mean these.
 “الْفَجْرُ” (*al-fajr*): the abundance of wealth and also philanthropy.
 “الْفَاجِرُ” (*al-faajir*): a wealthy man.
 “فَجَارَاتُ الْعَرَبِ” (*fijaaratul arb*): matters of Arab pride.
 “فَجَرَ الرَّجُلُ” (*fajar rajul*): the man became philanthropist.
 “تَفَجَّرَ بِالْكَرَمِ” (*tafajjar bil karam*): he was very generous {T, M}.

Words derived from this root have been used at different places:

- For water springs to come forth out of mountains (2:72, 2: 60).
- For water springs to sprout forth from ground (17:60).
- For canals or streams to gush forth (17:91).

About human self (& ego), Surah *Ash-Shams* says:

91:8	God has kept the knowledge as to what is right or wrong within the human conscience (common translation)	فَأَنهَمَهَا فُجُورَهَا وَتَقْوَاهَا
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As to how this differs from the *Quranic* teaching, see heading (L-H-M). Here it is enough to say that “فُجُورًا” (*fujuraha*) and “تَقْوَايَا” (*taqwaha*) have been used which are two conditions of a human personality.

“فَجَرَ” (*fajar*): to tear apart. Therefore for human personality to “فُجُورًا” (*fujuraha*) or “tear apart” would mean disintegration. Since “تَقْوَايَا” (*taqwaha*) has appeared opposite of it, it would mean for the human personality to be whole or to stay integrated. This is why, “مُتَّقِينَ” (*muttaqeen*) has appeared against “فُجُورًا” (*fujjar*) at other places such as (38:28).

“فَاجِرٌ” (*fajirun*) has been used in (71:27) where it means “he who has deviated from Allah’s path”. Anyone who deviates from Allah’s path, i.e. does not follow Allah’s laws, has his personality disintegrated. A developed personality’s distinctive feature is that it is integrated (unity of thought with the Attributes of Allah serving as a model), thus the above quoted verse of Surah *Ash-Shams* would mean that the human personality is endowed with the capability of integration or disintegration. Now every human being can consolidate his personality by following the Quranic Values and anyone who does not follow these follows would not benefit from this guidance.

To distinguish between good and bad is not within the human personality, but it can only be developed through the understanding and the application of the revelation. Only the divine message can tell as to what is good and what is not good for the human self. The Quranic guidance deals with the human thought process and that are why the Quran has declared that this is the book which deals with the healing of the hearts (10:58). Without the guidance of the Quran, nobody can distinguish between *khair* (good) and *sharr* (evil). There is nothing within us which can distinguish between the good and the bad. The so called conscience is the internalised society – whatever are the values of a society, those contribute to our conscience, of course depending upon our individual choices.

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“الْفَجْوَةُ” (*al-fajwah*): wide space: open space between two Things: vast expanse of land: vast ground or porch.
 “فَجَّابَهُ فَجْوًا” (*fajaaba bahu fajwa*): he opened his door.
 “الْفَجَا” (*al-faja*): the space between two calves or knees, or ankles {T, R}.

The Quran says about the fellowship of the cave:

18:17	they were in an open space inside the cave	وَهُمْ فِي فَجْوَةٍ مِنْهُ
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“الْفُحْشُ” (*al-fuhsh*): to cross limits, to be excessive, for something to be above limit, to exceed limits of courtesy in a talk.

“فُحْشُ الْأَمْرِ” (*fahushal-amr*): the matter crossed limits.

“الْفَاحِشُ” (*al-faahish*): one who exceeds the limit {T}.

The Quran has used “فَحْشَاءُ” (*fahsha-u*) against “عَدْلٌ” (*adlun*) in (16:90) and also against “قِسْطٌ” (*qist*) in (7:28-29).

In surah *Al-Ahzaab* this word has appeared against “قَنَاتٌ” (*qanatat*) which means obedience of Allah’s laws (30:31). See heading (Q-N-Y). Therefore “فُحْشٌ” (*fuhsh*) means to be go against the permanent values as defined and explained in the Quran. In other words, “فُحْشٌ” (*fuhsh*) means to be disobedient towards any of Allah’s laws and commit any ignominious act (3:134).

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings include fault in something.

“فَحْشَاءُ” (*fahsha-u*): miserliness.

“فَاحِشٌ” (*faahish*): stingy in spending on others {T}.

“أَفْحَشٌ” (*af-hasha*): he was a miser {M}.

The Quran has used this word to mean miserliness in (2:268) where it has appeared against “فَضْلٌ” (*fazl*) (2:268). “فَضْلٌ” (*fazl*): abundance, proliferation of sustenance. As such “فُحْشٌ” (*fuhsh*) would mean the narrowness or constriction of sustenance, sparseness, or to be miser in spending it. This is what miserliness is. “فَحْشَاءُ” (*fuhsha*) here would mean to acquire wealth from disallowed or unwarranted.

“الْفَوَاحِشُ” (*al-fawahish*): it is the plural of “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*faahisha*) and “الْفَحْشَاءُ” (*al-fah-shaa’u*) is the noun for “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*faahisha*) {T} that is “to ignore the limits”.

Surah *Bani Israel* includes fornication within “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*faahisha*) as in (17:32), but this does not mean that at every place where “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*faahisha*) has appeared it would mean fornication.

Surah *Al-Anam* says:

6:152	do not go near things that are <i>fawahish</i> , whether they be open or hidden	وَلَا تَقْرُبُوا الْفَوَاحِشَ مَا ظَهَرَ مِنْهَا وَمَا بَطَنَ
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Therefore “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*fawaish*) includes all sorts of excessiveness and shameful acts.

In surah *An-Nisa* where it has been said:

4:15	and those women among you who are alleged to have committed acts of <i>fahishaa</i> , bring four witnesses against them	وَالَّتِي يَأْتِيَنَّ الْفَاحِشَةَ مِنْ نِسَائِكُمْ فَاسْتَشْهِدُوا عَلَيْهِنَّ أَرْبَعَةً مِنْكُمْ
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Here “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*faahisha*) does not mean fornication or adultery because it is almost impossible to get four eye witnesses for such acts. Secondly, at another place the punishment for fornication is already said to be a hundred lashes (24:2), but here the punishment for “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*faahisha*) has been mentioned as keeping or confining them to home. Therefore at this place “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*faahisha*) is something less than fornication, which if not stopped, may lead to other evils in a society.

About the nation of *Loot* it has been said “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*faahisha*) in (7:80). In the next verse it has been clarified that it means homosexuality and not just fornication in traditional sense (7:81).

The very word “فَوَاحِشٌ” (*fawahish*) denotes that “فَاحِشَةٌ” (*faahisha*) not only means fornication but it also means all other shameful acts. These are the “فَوَاحِشٌ” (*fawaahish*) which have been mentioned above. The fact is that the result of fornication (not talking of professional women here) does not take place instantly.

For this a man and woman have to establish a relationship first. Then the relationship develops into further advances. Gradually these advances lead to fornication. The Quran wants us to stop these things which lead to fornication. These are the “فَوَاحِشٌ” (*fawaahish*) which have been mentioned above.

F-K-R

ف خ ر

“الْفَخْرُ” (*al-fakhur*): a female camel or a female goat which has big teats but little milk in them. or has a thin stream of milk {F}. This makes “الْفَخْرُ” (*al-fakhr's*) meaning clear. That is, to talk big and deliver very little, or to be proud of things which are not a part of human personality but may be additional, such as lineage, appearance, status, nationality, wealth, gender, colour, caste, etc {T}.

Ibn Faris says it is something which includes taking pride in the past.

“فُخْرٌ” (*fukhur*): having big teats but little milk (4:36-37).

Surah *Al-Hadeed* says “تَفَاخُرُ بَيْنَكُمْ” (*tafakh-khurun bainakum*) in (58:20). That is, to try to compete with each other with a view to exceed not on the basis of some personal trait of righteousness but on the basis of additional things as noted earlier. Man has the natural urge to compete and prove he is better than others, but the Quran says that instead of additional means, try to excel one another in righteousness (2:148).

“الْفَخَّارُ” (*al-fakh-khaar*): pieces of earthen utensils.

“فَخَّارٌ” (*fakh-khaar*) actually meant vessels to store water, which are empty inside but make a big sound {R}.

The Quran says:

55:14	Man has been created from dried mud like pieces of earthen utensils	خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ صَلْصَالٍ كَالْفَخَّارِ
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Details of this topic can be found in the book titled “*Iblees and Adam*”.

F-D-Y

ف د ي

“فَدَاةٌ” (*fadaah*), “يَفْدِيهِ” (*yafdeeh*), “فِدَاءٌ” (*fida-an*) and “فِدَى” (*fidyan*): he saved him from some catastrophe or misery by spending some money.

“تَفَادَى مِنْهُ” (*tafaada minhu*): saved himself from it.

“اِفْتَدَى بِهٖ بِكَذَا” (*iftada bihi bikaza*): he liberated himself in exchange for money.

“فَادَاةٌ مُفَادَاةٌ” (*faadaahu mufaadaat*): scholars have assigned different meanings to the word “فَادَاةٌ” (*faadaahu*). Among them are: “he liberated him by giving some money”, and also “he let him go after taking something”.

Some say that “مُفَادَاةٌ” (*mufaddaat*) is to give one man in and liberate another in exchange. But others think that there is no difference between the two meanings {T, M}.

However, the word does contain an element of saving someone.

Ibn Faris says it means to give a thing in exchange of another, in order to save it, protect it or liberate it.

In the Quran this has come to mean compensation to have the prisoners set free (2:58).

About *Ismail* it has been said:

37:107	We saved him from a very big sacrifice	وَقَدْ يَنْقُذُ بِذَبِيحٍ عَظِيمٍ
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Here this verse is referring to the responsibility of being a caretaker of the **Ka'ba** (2:125). This was a very big sacrifice i.e. to devote his entire life in the service of **Ka'ba**. This was the price he had to pay in exchange for his life.

About war, the Quran says:

47:4	Let them go either against money or in exchange of prisoners, in any case, you will have to let them go	فَأَمَّا مَنَّا بَعْدُ وَ إِمَّا فِدَاءً
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It is therefore entirely against the teachings of the Quran to turn prisoners into slaves. This was done in pre Islamic era, but the Quran closed this door to slavery. See details in heading **(M-L-K)**.

It must be noted that the verse (47:4) is not saying that prisoners of war will have to be freed immediately after they are captivated. This means that they cannot be turned into slaves. They may be imprisoned as per the need of times.

“فَشُدُّوا الرِّبَاطَ” (*fashuddul wisaaq*): the question of their disposal will arise when victory is achieved (47:4). Then it will be decided either to let them go free as a favour or in exchange of money as compensation.

F-R-T ف ر ت

“الْفُرَاتُ” (*al-furaat*): very sweet water:

Zamkhashri says it is called “فُرَاتٌ” (*furaat*) because “يَفْرُتُ الْعَطَشَ” (*yafrutul atash*) quenches thirst or breaks the intensity of thirst {T, M, R}.

Surah **Al-Muraasilah** says “مَاءٌ فُرَاتٌ” (*ma'un furaata*) in (77:27).
Surah **Al-Furqaan** says “عَذْبٌ فُرَاتٌ” (*azbun furaat*) in (25:53) i.e. very sweet.

F-R-Th ف ر ث

“الْفَرْثُ” (*al-fers*): food, when it is inside the entrails {T}.

Surah **An-Nahal** says that you must note how milk is prepared inside an animal's stomach between the “فَرَسٌ” (*faras*) and the blood like a clean source of nutrition (16:66).

“الْفَرْثُ” (*al-fars*): that which has been blown to smithereens {F}.

“فَرَسٌ” (*faras*): he scattered.

“فَرَسَ الْخُبَّ كَبِدَهُ” (*farasul hubbu kabeedah*): love broke his heart into pieces. Therefore “فَرَسٌ” (*fars*) is the condition of food which is broken into pieces inside the liver.

Scholars think that it means dung, but we think that it means the condition of an animal's food in which it is reduced to small bits in order to be digested inside the liver. **Lane** has also explained it as such.

“الْفَرْجُ” (*al-furju*), “الْفُرْجَةُ” (*al-furjah*): the gap between two things {T}.
 “بَابُ مَفْرُوجٍ” (*baabi-un mafrooj*): the gap of an open door.
 “تَفَارِيجُ الْأَصَابِعِ” (*tafaareejul asaabih*): the gap between fingers.
 “الْفَرْجُ” (*al-farj*): genitals, whether of a man or woman, or any and every place of danger.

The Quran says:

77:9	When the sky will be torn asunder (will be forced apart)	إِذَا السَّمَاءُ فُرِجَتْ
84:1	When the sky will be torn asunder	إِذَا السَّمَاءُ انشَقَّتْ
50:6	There is no gap (crack or fault) in between them	مَا لَهَا مِنْ فُرُوجٍ
67:3	Do you see any fault anywhere?	هَلْ تَرَى مِنْ فُطُورٍ

The Quran has laid a lot of stress on protecting one's chastity, as is said about the men and women:

24:30	let them (men) protect their chastity	يَحْفَظُوا فُرُوجَهُمْ
24:31	let them (women) protect their chastity	يَحْفَظْنَ فُرُوجَهُنَّ
21:91	he who protected his chastity	وَالَّذِي أَحْصَنَتْ فَرْجَهَا

These instances make it clear that “فَرْجٌ” (*farj*) does not only mean the genitals, but also chastity or faults. This should be kept in mind when translating whenever the word appears in the Quran.

“الْفَرْحُ” (*al-farah*): the dictionary says that this word is the opposite of “حُزْنٌ” (*huzn*) or sadness.

Raghib says this means palpitation or fast heart beat at temporary pleasure, and “سُرُورٌ” (*suroor*) is the contentment which is obtained from temporary as well as permanent pleasure. But without regard to this distinction, these words are sometimes used to mean the same {T}.

Surah *Yunus* says about the Quran:

10:58	they should celebrate the advent of the Quran	فَبِذَلِكَ فَلْيَفْرَحُوا
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It also means to preen vainly {T}.

Surah *An-Namal* says:

27:36	You are very proud of your gift (as if it is a great thing)	بَلْ أَنْتُمْ بِحَدِّ نِعْمَتِكُمْ تَفْرَحُونَ
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Surah *Al-Qasas* says that the people of *Qaaroona's* nation told him:

28:76	Do not exult because Allah does not like those who exult	لَا تَفْرَحْ إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ الْفَرِحِينَ
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These places indicate that they point to egotism which is often created in the novae riche.

Surah *Ar-Room* tells the *muslims* not to revert to *shirk* after accepting Islam i.e. not turn into sects in which the condition becomes such that:

30:32	every sect prides itself that it is the only right one and that all others are on the wrong path	كُلُّ حِزْبٍ بِمَا لَدَيْهِمْ فَرِحُونَ
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In surah *Aal-e-Imran*, “تَسْوُبُ” (*tas-uhum*) has appeared against “يَفْرَحُوا بِهَا” (*yafrihu biha*) in (3:119). That is “to feel bad”. In (13:36) “يُنْكِرُ” (*yunkar*) has been used against it, which means to take umbrage. “يَقْنَطُونَ” (*yuqnatoon*) has been used against it in surah *Ar-Room* i.e. “to become without hope” and in surah *Al-Hadeed* it has come against “تَأْسَوُا” (*ta'sau*) which means “to feel sorry” (57:23). These examples make the meaning of “فَرْحٌ” (*farah*) clear.

“الْفَرْدُ” (*al-fard*) alone: by himself:

“زَوْجٌ” (*zaujun*): a pair and every one of the pair are called “فَرْدٌ” (*fard*) a thing which has no parallel.

“نَاقَةٌ فَارِدَةٌ” (*naaqatun faaridah*): the camel which grazes away from the others in the grazing field {T}.

Raghib says “الْفَرْدُ” (*al-fard*): a thing with which no other thing is mixed.

“مُنْفَرِدٌ” (*munfarid*): unique (different from others) {R}.

Surah *Al-Anbia* says that **Zakaria** prayed:

21:89	O' my Lord, do not leave me alone	رَبِّ لَا تَذَرْنِي فَرْدًا
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Since he had prayed for progeny, here it would mean that he wanted children.

Surah *Mariyam* says:

19:95	At the time results of deeds are made known, nobody will be able to interfere in anyone's result	كُلُّهُمْ أِنْتِهِ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ فَرْدًا
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That is, nobody can be able to support anyone. This has been repeated in (4:95) about laws regarding natural turn of events. The Quran has said that every person only affects himself by the result of his deeds. This shows the individuality or uniqueness of every personality. Freedom and individuality are the basic characteristics of a human personality.

The Quran says:

6:95	And you come to Us with the same individuality that we had created you with	وَلَقَدْ جِئْتُمُونَا فُرَادَىٰ كَمَا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ
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Here it is pointed towards the individuality of a human personality. For his self-interest a man makes a lot of companions and creates a lot of means to attain those interests, but the result of his deeds affect his own personality and nobody can share these results nor can all his wealth protect him from those results. This is inbuilt within the human self through the medium of thinking and memory.

The consequential law is a great reality. The entire edifice of humanity is based on it. The result of every deed affects man's own personality. We cannot transfer any of the results of these deeds to anyone else, nor can anyone else transfer his results to us. This is the proof of the unique personality of a man i.e. my pleasures are solely mine and my worries only belong to me.

“الْفَرْدَسَةُ” (*al-fardasah*): vastness and expansiveness.

“صِدْرٌ مُّفَرَّدَسٌ” (*sadrun mufardas*): a big and expansive chest.

“رَجُلٌ فَرَادِسٌ” (*rajulun furadas*): a man with large bones.

“الْفُرْدَاوسُ” (*al-furdaus*): proliferation in edibles, or a dinner party.

“كَرْمٌ مُّفَرَّدَسٌ” (*karmun mufardas*): grape vines which are boosted on bamboo sheets.

“فِرْدَاوسٌ” (*firdaus*): a green valley: garden where all kinds of trees abound.

The Syrians used to call gardens and fertile places as “فَرَادِيسُ” (*faradees*). Some think that this word is Syrian or may be Roman, but **Ibnul Qata** says that it is Arabic and derived from “الْفَرْدَسَةُ” (*al-furdasa*) {T, M}.

The Quran says “جَنَّاتُ الْفِرْدَاوسِ” (*jannatul firdaus*) in (18:107), that is, vast green and fruitful gardens, or a heavenly society in this world where there are all kinds of abundances and every kind of ‘greenery’ and ‘flowering’ in the hereafter.

“الْفَرُّ” (*al-farr*), “الْفِرَارُ” (*al-firaar*): to run away scared from something {T}.

The basic meaning of this root is to open or liberate something {M, F}.

“فَرَّ” (*farr*): for the animals to bare their teeth.

“اِفْتَرَارٌ” (*iftiraar*): to show one’s teeth while laughing {R}.

“الْفَرُّ” (*al-farr*): escapers. It is the plural of “فَارٌّ” (*faarr*). “الْفَرُّ” (*al-farr*) itself is used as a singular word.

“كَتَيْبَةُ فُرَى” (*kateebatun farra*): defeated soldiers who ran away {M, F}.

The Quran has used this word to mean “escape”:

18:18	Escape	فِرَارًا
74:51	Were afraid of the lion and escaped	فَرَّتْ مِنْ قَسْوَرَةٍ
71:6	The more I called them towards me the more they ran away from me	فَلَمْ يَرْدَهُمْ دُعَائِي إِلَّا فِرَارًا
75:10	Where will you run to?	أَيْنَ الْمَفَرِّ
51:50	to return to Allah (i.e. return to the Law of requital)	فَقَرُّوا إِلَى اللَّهِ

For more details see heading (*R-J-Ain*).

“فَرَشَ” (*farsh*): to spread out something on the floor, or to spread something in general.

“الْفَرَشُ” (*al-farsh*): the flooring that is spread out in homes, or crop which well spreads out in the land. It also means wide and expansive atmosphere.

“الْفَرِيشُ” (*al-fareesh*): the vine that spreads out on the ground {T}.

“الْفَرَّاشَةُ” (*al-farashah*): a flying insect, like a butterfly etc.

“الْفَرَاشُ” (*al-farash*) is the plural as used in (101:4).

“فِرَاشٌ” (*firashun*): anything that is spread out on the ground.

Surah *Al-Anam* says:

6:142	And of the cattle, some are for carrying load and some are to eat.	وَمِنَ الْإِنْعَامِ حَمُولَةٌ وَفَرَشَاءٌ
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Faraa says “حَمُولَةٌ” (*hamulatah*) are animals capable of carrying a load or fit for travelling.

“فَرَشَاءٌ” (*farshun*): animals which are incapable of carrying load and thus unfit for travelling {T}.

Muheet says “فَرَشَاءٌ” (*farsha*) are young camels.

Ibn Faris says its meaning refers to those four legged animals which can be slaughtered and are edible.

Surah *Ar-Rahman* says:

55:54	Reclining on couches	مُتَكَبِّرِينَ عَلَى فُرُشٍ
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It is the opposite of “فِرَاشٌ” (*firaash*), that is, things which have been laid out.

Surah *Az-Zaariyat* says:

51:48	We have spread out the earth	وَالْأَرْجَ فَرَشْنَاهَا
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Surah *Al-Waaqiah* says:

56:34	And companions raised high in status	وَفُرُشٍ مَرْفُوعَةٍ
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Here “فُرُشٌ” (*furushun*) mean wives.

“مَرْفُوعٌ” (*marfu-aa*): of high rank.

Ibn Faris says that “الْفِرَاشُ” (*al-firaash*) means wife or husband but it is more referred to the meaning of a wife.

F-R-Zd ف ر ض

“الْفَرْضُ” (*al-farz*): to cut something very hard: since one considers as to where the cutting should begin, this word has come to mean to assess:

“الْفَرِيزَةُ” (*al-fareeza*): the designated part: anything which is designated or fixed.

“أَفْرَضَ لَهُ” (*afraza lahu*): designated or fixed something for him.

“فَرَضَ لَهُ فِي الدِّيَّانِ” (*faraz lahu fid diwaan*): registered him in the salary register.

“إِفْتَرَضَ الْجُنْدُ” (*tarazal-jund*): the army recovered that which was due to it or its salary {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says that since a thing gets marked by cutting into it, “الْفَرْضُ” (*al-farz*) means duty because its parameters are designated.

The Quran says about that a women’s wedding compensation money is “فَرِيزَةٌ” (*fareeza*) because a fixed sum is designated upon oneself (the husband). A part of the heirloom is called “تَصْيِيًّا مَفْرُوضًا” (*naseeban mafrooza*) as in (4:7), because it too is a fixed part.

In surah **At-Taubah** the principle of distribution of “صدقات” (*sadaqah*) has been laid out:

9:60	The principle of division as fixed by Allah’s laws	فَرِيزَةٌ مِنَ اللَّهِ
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Surah **An-Noor** says:

24:1	The surah which was revealed by Allah and the orders given therein were designated as farz (a duty & a responsibility)	سُورَةٌ أَنْزَلْنَاهَا وَفَرَضْنَاهَا
28:85	Without doubt, the personality which has designated the Quran as a duty for you	إِنَّ الَّذِي فَرَضَ عَلَيْكَ الْقُرْآنَ

The entire gamut of **Quranic** orders are in fact a duty (& a responsibility) from Allah, so all its orders must be carried out to get the benefits which are associated with the following of these permanent values. These benefits are for the good of mankind in this life as well as the next life.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says about the cow or ox of the Israelis:

2:68	Neither very young nor very old	لَا فَارِضٌ وَلَا بَكْرٌ
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Johri says that any big or old thing is called “فَارِضٌ” (*faariz*) because it is only an old tree which gets cut down {*T, M*}.

Whatever the Quran has ordered is “فَرْضٌ” (*farz*) or a duty, and that which it has stopped from doing is forbidden. Therefore other terms which are used with “فَرْضٌ” (*farz*) like “واجب” (*waajib*) and “مستحب” (*mustahib*) etc. or terms like “مكروه” (*makroohi*), “تحريمي” (*tehrimi*) etc. which are used with the word “حرام” (*haraam*) may be words of the dictionary, but these are not the **Quranic** terms.

Surah **At-Tahreem** says:

66:2	It is incumbent upon you to dissolve such commitments which have made declare lawful things as unlawful (i.e. anything which goes against the Quran must be annulled).	قَدْ فَرَضَ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ تَحِلَّةَ أَيْمَانِكُمْ
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Surah *Al-Ahzaab* says:

33:38	things which have been fixed for the messenger have no constriction	مَا كَانَ عَلَى النَّبِيِّ مِنْ حَرَجٍ فِيمَا فَرَضَ اللَّهُ لَهُ
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This is a generality and it has no connection with the foregoing verse which was related to the matter in reference of *Zaid*.

F-R-Te ف ر ط

The basic meaning of “فَرَطَ” (*farat*) is to excel and go beyond {M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to move a thing from its place and to move it to one side. One who goes ahead pushes the others back as he goes ahead.

“الْفُرُطُ” (*al-furut*): fast horse which leaves all other horses behind {T}.
The difference between “إِفْرَاطٌ” (*ifraat*) and “تَفْرِيطٌ” (*tafreet*) is that “إِفْرَاطٌ” (*ifraat*) means to proceed towards excess and excellence, while “تَفْرِيطٌ” (*tafreet*) means to go below the prescribed limit {M}.
“فَرَطَ عَلَيْهِ” (*farata ilaih*): committed excess on him, or dealt with him discourteously in a hurry {T}.

The Quran says

20:44	we are afraid lest he commits excesses on us	إِنَّا نَخَافُ أَنْ يُفْرِطَ عَلَيْنَا
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“فَرَطَ” (*farrat*): to be less in something, or to lack, or to waste.

Lataif-ul-Lagha also says that “فَرَطَ” (*farrat*) means to do less in something, and “أَفْرَاطٌ” (*afraat*) is to exceed the limit.

The Quran says:

6:31	They will say we are ashamed at how we underestimated the consequential law.	قَالُوا لِحُسْرَتِنَا عَلَى مَا فَرَطْنَا فِيهَا
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“فَرَطَ” (*farrata*) and “أَفْرَاطٌ” (*afraat*) mean also to let someone stew in his own juice and not bother about him.

“فَرَطَتِ النَّخْلَةُ” (*furritatin nakhlah*): the dates were left on their own.
“أَفْرَطَ الْأَمْرَ” (*afrat-al-amr*): he forgot that he gave it up {M}.

The Quran says:

16:62	And they will be among those who are left behind	وَأَنَّهُمْ مُفْرَطُونَ
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This means that others will proceed beyond them. This is a basic difference between *jahannam* and *jannat*. In *jahannam* the development of a man is stilted and in *jannat* he continues to go ahead in development. He becomes static in *jahannam*.

“الْأَمْرُ الْفُرُطُ” (*al-amrul furut*): the thing in which man crosses a limit {M}.

The Quran says:

18:28	This matter has crossed the limit	وَكَانَ أَمْرُهُ فُرُطًا
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Raghib says “الْفَرُطُ” (*al-fert*) means to proceed intentionally, that is, there is intent and purpose in it.

Surah *Al-Anam* says that the birds which fly in the air and the animals which traverse the earth are “أَمَمٌ” (*umam*) like you. After this it is said:

6:39	We have not let the book lack any thing	مَا فَرَطْنَا فِي الْكِتَابِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ
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According to the context, “الكتاب” (*al-kitaab*) here can mean law of nature, but even if it means the Quran itself, then too the meaning is clear, because whatever is said in the Quran has been completely explained. There are no lacunae in it. This has been referred and confirmed at many other places.

F-R-Ain ف ر ع

“فَرَعُ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*far-u kulli shaiyi*): the highest part of anything
 “الْفَرْعَةُ” (*al-far’ah*): the peak of a mountain.
 “فَارِعَةُ الْجَبَلِ” (*faari’atul jabal*): the highest part of a mountain {T}. Besides height, this word is used to mean length as well.
 “السُّفْرُغُ” (*al-mufri’u*): any long thing {T}.
 “فَرْعُ الشَّجَرِ” (*far-ush shajar*): a branch of a tree, because as compared to its base or root, it is longer and higher {R}.

The Quran has said:

14:24	its roots are very strong and branches spread out in the sky	أَصْلُهَا ثَابِتٌ وَفُرُوعُهَا فِي السَّمَاءِ
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Fir’oun فرعون

It was the title of ancient Egyptian kings. For details see heading “*Moosa*”.

F-R-Gh ف ر غ

“فَرَاغٌ” (*faragh*), “فُرُوغًا” (*furugha*): to be empty.
 “فَارِغٌ” (*faarig*): empty {T}.

28:10	<i>Moosa’s</i> mother’s heart became bereft of patience	وَأَصْبَحَ فُؤَادُ أُمِّ مُوسَى فَارِغًا
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In other words, she lost patience, or became disturbed.

“فَرَعَ لَهُ وَآلِيهِ” (*faragha lahu wa ilaih*): to attend to something with full concentration, or to intend to do something {T}.

Surah *Ar-Rahman* says:

55:3	O <i>Saqlain</i> , we will attend to you when it is your turn	سَنَفْرُغُ لَكُمْ أَيُّهَ الثَّقَلَانِ
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But this does not mean that God is busy in some other work.

“الْفِرَاغُ” (*al-firaagh*): the side of a well’s bucket out of which water is poured {T}.
 “أَفْرَغَ” (*afragh*): to pour, to spill {T}.
 “أَفْرَغَ عَلَيْنَا صَبْرًا” (*afriqh alaina sabra*): pour solidarity and perseverance over us profusely (7:126).
 “الْفِرَاغُ” (*al-firaagh*): a big utensil or pool made of leather product {T}.

In Surah *Al-Sharh* the messenger is told that now that all those worries that were breaking your back in implementing Allah’s program have been removed, continue your program with equanimity:

94:7	The initial part of the program in which there were obstructions at every step have been eliminated.	فَإِذَا فُزِعْتِ فَأَنْتَبِ
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Due to this obstruction the constructive part of this program could not be implemented. The messenger was then told to concentrate on fulfilling this program with all his attention. Usually when a man is out of the woods or difficulties, he rests contently. But when Allah’s program begins and there is no time to be complacent, then more work than before has to be done all the time. This constructive program is for the

development of the entire humanity and is no easy job. The Quranic programme should continue 24/7 on a continuous and sustainable basis.

F-R-Q

ف ر ق

“الْفَرْقُ” (*al-farq*): the hairline by which hair is parted on either side of the head. This is its basic meaning.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is to separate one thing from another.

“الْمَفْرَقُ” (*al-mafraq*): the place where hair is parted.

“مَفْرَقُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*mafraquṭ tareeq*): the place where a tributary sprouts from a path.

“الْفَارِقُ” (*al-fariq*): the cloud which, away from other clouds, brings rain.

“أَرْضُ فَرَقَةٍ” (*ardun fariqah*): the land where plants grow on some distance from each other {T}.

“الْفَرْقُ” (*al-farq*): to separate one thing from another, or to decide, or to explain something explicitly and separately.

“فَرَقَ لَهُ الطَّرِيقُ” (*faraqa lahu tareeq*): the path became distinct out of two paths for him.

“فَرَقَ لَهُ أَمْرٌ” (*faraqa lahu amr*): the thing became clear and was clearly understood {T}.

“فَرَقَهُ” (*faraqah*): made it distinct.

“الْفَرْقُ” (*al-farqu*) and “الْفَرْقُ” (*al-faraq*): they meant a measure which was used in *Medina*.

“فَرَقَ” (*fariqa*): he drank from a utensil {T}.

“الْفَرِيقُ” (*al-fareeq*): a group which breaks away from the others.

“تَفْرِيقُ” (*tafreeq*): to separate or divide with the purpose of creating chaos, or to create division and dissention {T}.

“الْفِرْقُ” (*al-firq*): the part that breaks away (26:64).

“الْفِرْقَةُ” (*al-firqah*): a group or a party (9:12).

The Quran has been called “فُرْقَانٌ” (*furqaan*) in (3:3) because it separates the truth and the falsehood from each other. It could also be because it is the criterion which proves the mettle of every man, i.e. the collection of the permanent values. The book revealed to *Moosa* has also been called “فُرْقَانٌ” (*furqaan*) in (21:48, 2:53). Allah’s given guidance has also been called “فُرْقَانٌ” (*furqaan*), i.e. it differentiates clearly between truth and falsehood.

“يَوْمَ الْفُرْقَانِ” (*yaumul fiurqaan*) is usually taken to mean the battle of *Badar* in which the truth and falsehood got clearly positioned (8:41).

In surah *Al-Infal*, *muslims* have been told that if they oversee or observe the laws of Allah:

8:49	Allah will grant you a distinguished life	يَجْعَلْ لَكُمْ فُرْقَانًا
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A *momin* through his own free choice accepts Islam as explained in the Quran using his intellect and reasoning and lives a distinguished life - a life of such high character as defined in the Quran that everyone acknowledges that he is above others who have not accepted the permanent values. The life of a *momin* should distinctly separate the truth from the falsehood in this world.

The Quran says that Allah has declared the *Muslims* as one group or party. The existence of separate groups in this unitary party is a direct form of *shirk* and those who do so are *mushrikeen* (30:32). Such people have no connection with Allah or His messenger (6:159). After this clear decision of the Quran about sectarianism, nothing more needs to be said in this connection!

The unity of the Creator must be reflected in the unity of his creation, i.e. the mankind. Similarly, it is wrong to divide sovereignty as directed in the Quran into pieces because that would be like dividing the humanity. The unity of the humanity is created only by a unitary code of life. Sectarianism means that different sects live their life according to different codes of life, and this is not allowed as this is the cause of all mutual conflicts between human beings.

Surah *At-Taubah* mentions “قَوْمٌ يَفْرُقُونَ” (*qaumun yafraqoon*) in (9:56).

Raghib says “فَرَقَ” (*faraq*) means for the heart to palpitate due to fear or to be confused due to fear. It can also mean that those, whom peace has left, are frightened people.

“فَارَقَ” (*faaraq*): to give up, to part with.
 “فَارَقُوهُمْ” (*faariquhunna*): part with them (56:2).

F-R-He ف ر ه

“فَارِهٌ” (*faruh*), “يَفْرُهُ” (*yafruh*): to be an expert, to be agile, to be beautiful. Its plurals are “فَارِيهُونَ” (*faarihoon*) and “فَارِيهِينَ” (*faariheen*).
 “الْفَارِيهَةُ” (*al-faarihat*): a beautiful slave girl, or a woman who eats excessively.
 “فَرِهَ” (*fariha*): to be vain and flaunt {T, M, R}.

The Quran says about the nation of **Samood**:

26:149	you carve big palaces and forts out of these mountains	وَتَنْحِتُونَ مِنَ الْجِبَالِ بُيُوتًا فَرِهِينَ
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Another meaning is “you carve out big houses out of these mountains and are proud of them”. If both meanings are conjoined then the meaning would be such palatial buildings which are made with great expertise and pride.

F-R-Y ف ر ي

“الْفَرَى” (*al-far'yu*): to cut or tear cloth or leather in order to mend or sew it.
 “الْإِفْرَاءُ” (*al-ifra'a*): to cut or tear in order to spoil it.
 “الْإِفْرَاءُ” (*al-iftraa*): to change the real meaning: it can have both meanings i.e. to improve it or to create discord in it {T, R}.

Raghib says the Quran uses it to mean exaggeration, lies, and mixing other laws with laws of Allah.

“الْفَرِيءُ” (*al-fariyyu*): a fabricated thing, an invented thing, a great and important thing, or a surprising thing.
 “هُوَ يَفْرِى الْفَرِيءَ” (*huwa yafil fariyyu*): he does a surprising thing {T, M}.

The leaders of the Jewish temple said to **Maryam**:

19:27	you have violated our code in living like a hermit	لَقَدْ جِئْتَ شَيْءًا فَرِيئًا
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A second meaning is that Isa was a surprising child whom **Maryam** had brought to them.

Ibn Faris says “الْفَرَى” (*al-fraa*) means to be surprised and wonderstruck.

Al-Muftari says it means one who fabricates or exaggerates.

16:101	They say, ‘you are but a forger’	قَالُوا إِنَّمَا أَنْتَ مُفْتَرٍ
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“مُفْتَرٍ” (*mutara*): fabricated, invented (28:36).
 “إِفْتَرَى عَلَى” (*iftara ala*): to fabricate an accusation and attribute it to others (3:93).

“فَزَّ فُلَانًا عَنْ مَوْضِعِهِ” (*fazza fulana un mauzihi*): removed that man from his place.

“فَزَّ عَنْهُ” (*fazza unhu*): he separated from him, or moved to one side.

“فَزَّ الطَّبْيُ يَزُّ” (*fazzaz zabu bifazz*): the deer was disturbed {T, M}.

“إِسْتَفَزَّهُ” (*istafaazahu*): expelled him from his house and disturbed him, or underestimated him to be light-weighted, or shook him and tried to bond with him.

“إِسْتَفَزَّهُ الْخَوْفُ” (*istafazzal-khauf*): fear disturbed him, or removed him from his place and carried him along {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says this root basically means to be of low standard.

Therefore it's connotations include disturbance of the heart and to physically move away from one's place, as well as to be light and be displaced. Hence it also means to unbalance someone somehow, and in this way displace him.

The Quran tells the **Iblees**:

17:24	Whom you can overpower or mislead and thus displace them from the right path	وَأَسْتَفْزِرُّ مَنِ اسْتَطَعْتَ مِنْهُمْ
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About the Pharaoh it is said:

17:103	He wants to disturb them and move them from their stance	فَارَادَ أَنْ يَسْتَفْزِرَّهُمْ مِنَ الْأَرْضِ
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It may also mean “to lie in wait” and “to deceive into destruction” {T}.

“الْفَزَعُ” (*al-fazi'o*): palpitation, fear.

Mubaarad has said in his book **Kamil** that “فَزَعٌ” (*fazigh*) means fear. Later it came to mean “to come out quickly to defend in the event of enemy attack” {T}.

Raghib says it means the palpitation and worry caused by a thing of fear {R}.

“الْفَزَعُ” (*al-faza'u*): to plead to someone, to accept pleading, or the thing someone pleads for.

“فَزَعِ النَّبِيَّ” (*afza'a hum*): “frightened them” or “relieved them of fear”.

“فَزَّ عَنْهُ” (*fazza'u*): he frightened him and troubled him.

“أَفَزَّ عَنْهُمْ” (*fazza-u unhu*): removed palpitation and fear from him {T}.

The Quran says:

21:103	They will not be worried over even the biggest difficulty or palpitation	لَا يَحْزَنُهُمُ الْفَزَعُ الْأَكْبَرُ
27:89	They will be safe from palpitation on that day	وَهُمْ مِنْ فَزَعٍ يَوْمَئِذٍ آمِنُونَ
27:87	everything in the universe will be troubled	فَفَزَعَتْ مِنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَمَنْ فِي الْأَرْضِ
34:23	when tribulation will be removed from their hearts	حَتَّى إِذَا فُزِعَ عَنْ قُلُوبِهِمْ

“الْفُسْحَى” (*al-fius*), “الْفَاحِشَاتُ” (*al-faahisahhah*): abundance and profusion.
 “فُسْحَ الْمَكَانِ” (*fasuhal-makaan*): the space widened:
 “انْفَسَحَ صَدْرُهُ” (*infasaha sadruhu*): his chest opened: his heart expanded:
 “فَسَّحَ لَهُ فِي الْمَجْلِسِ” (*fasaha ahul majlis*): he created a space for him in the seating {T}

The Quran says:

58:11	When you are told to sit comfortably in a gathering, then do that. Allah will create space for you	إِذَا قِيلَ لَكُمْ تَفَسَّحُوا فِي الْمَجْلِسِ فَانْفَسِحُوا يَفْسَحِ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ
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“فَسَدَ الشَّيْءُ” (*fasadah shaiyi*): for a thing to go bad, or for it to not remain in its former balanced state.
 “لَحْمٌ فَاسِدٌ” (*lahmun faasid*): meat that has become rotten and useless.
 “فَسَادٌ” (*fasaad*): is the opposite of “صَلَاحٌ” (*salaah*) which means gain balance.

“فَسَادٌ” (*fasaad*) have different uses, as:

- to not be in balance
- for disorder to take place {*T, M, R*}.
- destruction of a generation (2:205).
- not to keep or give full measure
- not to give the full compensation to others' labour.
- create economic unbalance
- suppress people's rights
- to upset a righteous system
- upset the right order of things (27:34)
- committing a crime (12:73)

“فَسَادٌ” (*fasaad*) is actually the creation of non-egalitarianism in society, whatever form it takes.

For a clearer meaning of this root, see the heading (**Sd-L-H**) because you cannot understand the proper meaning of “فَسَادٌ” (*fasaad*) unless the meaning of “صَلَاحٌ” (*salaah*) is well understood.

The Quran has used “مُصْلِحِينَ” (*musliheen*) opposite to “مُفْسِدِينَ” (*mufsideen*) in 2:11.

Those who are intoxicated with wealth and greed do this (7:74).

The scheme of the **Pharaohs** is described as to create different parties within the nation and to create disharmony among these parties. Whereas the Quran guides us by explaining that people should create harmony among themselves on a global basis. It means they only keep according to their needs, and give away rest for the development of others. In this way all will participate in creating balance, and not creating chaos in the world by seizing and accumulating more than necessary (2:60). However, this is only possible on a global basis when people accept the values explained in the Quran and aspire for a higher purpose of life.

Surah **Ash-Shura** calls “مُسْرِفِينَ” (*musrifeen*) as “مُفْسِدِينَ” (*mufsideen*) in (26:151-152).
 In surah **Al-Qasas**, this word has appeared against “أَحْسَنَ” (*ahsan*) (28:77).

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says that the **malaikah** objected to the creation of Adam and stated that he would lead to “فَسَادٌ” (*fasaad*) and bloodshed on earth:

2:31	We are always engaged in pursuing your program (by completing it) and go as far as necessary to implement it (then why would you need Adam?)	نَحْنُ نُسَبِّحُ بِحَمْدِكَ وَنُقَدِّسُ لَكَ
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It is obvious that going against the program which God has given for the humans is also “فَسَادٌ” (*fasaad*). This not only creates chaos in man’s own personality, but also creates disorder in a human society. This vast universal system beyond the human control is running so well, because everything in it is following the one and only program created and directed by God (through His laws). If more than one God’s laws or systems would be at work, then chaos would certainly have resulted.

21:22	Human life can only be lived peacefully and smoothly if it is spent according to the code of Allah only.	لَوْ كَانَ فِيهِمَا آلِهَةٌ إِلَّا اللَّهُ لَفَسَدَتِ
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F-S-R ف س ر

“الْفَسْرُ” (*al-fasr*): to make evident, to expostulate, to open or make a hidden matter known.
 “فَسِرَ” (*fasar*), “يَفْسِرُ” (*yafsir*), and “يَفْسُرُ” (*yafsur*): to make evident.
 “فَسَّرَ” (*fassara*): the same as above, but it also has the connotation of exaggeration.
 “التَّفْسِيرَةُ” (*at-tafsirah*): to test something {*T, M, R*}.

Allah has said about the Quran:

25:33	It has been explained very beautifully by God Himself	وَ أَحْسَنَ تَفْسِيرًا
75:19	It is on Us to make it explain it	ثُمَّ إِنَّ عَلَيْنَا بَيَانَهُ

This explaining is done by explanatory verses, i.e. by reiterating a thing in different verses (6:65). Therefore the Quran is itself its own explanation, and its claims are verified by creations in the universe and by historical facts, or by the happy results that will be manifested by implementing its system.

F-S-Q ف س ق

“فَسِقٌ” (*fisq*): to go beyond the circle of the truth.
 “فَسَقَتِ الرُّطْبَةُ عَنْ قَشْرِبَا” (*fasaqatir rutubatu un qisrihsa*): the fat date came out of its cover. There is a membrane over the date fruit, inside which the fruit develops and is nurtured and ripens. This happens with every fruit that it gets nurtured within a membrane or cover. But sometimes this cover or membrane gets damaged, or the fruit comes out of it from one side. Under such conditions this fruit will not reach its full potential and not be as good as a normal one. This condition is described by the Arabs as “فَسَقَتِ الرُّطْبَةُ” (*fasaqatir rutuba an qishraha*).

In the pre-Islamic era, this expression existed but was never used for humans {*T, M*}. The Quran used this expression for humans and presented the shell of such a society in which man could attain the right sort of development. The individual or group which goes out of this kind of shell or form is called “فَاسِقٌ” (*faasiq*) and cannot develop properly. Therefore any individual who goes out of the boundaries set by the Quranic system is a “فَاسِقٌ” (*faasiq*).

The Quran has explained the words where it first appears as:

2:26 2:27	<i>Fasiqeen</i> are those who break the pact that they have made with Allah, and break the bond itself into pieces (bond of humanity) and create unevenness in human society.	الَّذِينَ يَنْقُضُونَ عَهْدَ اللَّهِ مِنْ بَعْدِ مِيثَاقِهِ وَ يَقْطَعُونَ مَا أَمَرَ اللَّهُ بِهِ أَنْ يُوصَلَ وَيُفْسِدُونَ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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“ظَالِمِينَ” (*zalimeen*) and “كَافِرِينَ” (*kafireen*) has also been called “فَاسِقِينَ” (*faasiqeen*) (2:59, 2:99), as well as those who find ways to avoid the laws of Allah while living in a society (3:81).

In surah *Al-Ma'idah* the word has been used for those who violate Allah’s laws, whether the orders are big or small (5:3). That is, every violator or criminal is a *faasiq*, because even a little opening in the membrane of the date makes the date faulty. *Momin* and *faasiq* are opposites (3:106).

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:197	No wickedness and no quarrelling during <i>Hajj</i>	لَا تُسَوِّقْ وَلَا جِدَالَ فِي الْحَجِّ
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Generally it is taken to mean swearing or ill manners, but it means that during the congregation of Hajj, nothing should be done or said which can create problems and lead to deviation from the purpose of Hajj.

F-Sh-L ف ش ل

- “فَشِيلَ” (*fashil*), “يَفْشَلُ” (*yafshal*): to become a coward {T, M}.
- “الْفَشْلُ” (*al-fishal*): the curtain of the howdah behind which the women sit, or the cushion on which a woman sits in a howdah.
- “فَشِيلَ” (*fashil*): to become fretful or weak like a weak women.
- “الْيَدُ الْفَشْلَاءُ” (*al-yadul fashla-u*): the left hand which is usually weaker than the right {M}. This is a commoner’s language not a dictionary word.
- “فَشْلُنْ” (*fashlun*) has the connotation of cowardice along with weakness {R}.

The Quran says:

8:46	Do not engage in mutual bickering	وَلَا تَنَازَعُوا فَتَفْشَلُوا
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If you do so, then as a result you will become weak and coward, or weak and bicker like a weak woman {T}.

Ibn Faris says “تَفَشَّلَ الْمَاءُ” (*tafash shalal-ma’u*) means that the water started to flow. This too indicates weakness and lack of stability i.e. for the strengths to go waste and thus be weak.

F-Sd-H ف ص ح

- “الْفَصْحُ” (*al-fas’h*): to become evident and clear. The scholars of *Ashtaqaq* say that there is a connotation of becoming evident in this term. The language which makes the meanings explicitly clear will be called “فَصِيحٌ” (*faseeh*): the man too whose talk is very clear and has no ambiguity will also be called “فَصِيحٌ” (*faseeh*).
- “الْفَصَاحَةُ” (*al-fasahatu*): for the talk to be very clear.
- “أَفْصَحَتِ الشَّاءُ” (*afsahatish shah*): clean milk that comes a day or two after colostrum.
- “أَفْصَحَ الصُّبْحُ” (*afsahas subh*): the morning became bright and clear.
- “فَصْحٌ” (*fashun*): milk from which all cream has been cleansed.
- “الْفَصْحُ” (*al-fasah*): to clear something that usually gets mixed up with something {T, M, R}

The Quran mentions *Moosa* saying about *Haroon*, his brother:

28:34	He is more eloquent than I am.	هُوَ أَفْصَحُ مِنِّي
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F-Sd-L ف ص ل

- “الْفَصْلُ” (*al-fasl*): the border between two things {*Lataif-ul-Lagha*}. It means to separate a thing from something else so clearly that the distinction gets clear.
- “الْفَاصِلَةُ” (*al-faasilah*): the pearl which comes between two pearls to distinguish them.
- “الْمَفَاصِلُ” (*al-mafaasil*): the joints of a body, or the space between mountains where water flows.
- “فَصْلُ الْخُطَابِ” (*faslul khitaab*): decisive talk (38:20).
- “التَّفْصِيلُ” (*at-tafseel*): to separate, or to make evident and highlight.
- “آيَاتٌ مُفَصَّلَاتٌ” (*aayaatun mufassilaat*): clear indications.
- “الْإِنْفِصَالُ” (*al-infisaal*): to be separated.
- “فَصَالٌ” (*fisaalun*): to make a child leave mother’s milk {T, R} (2:233).
- “فَصَّلَ الشَّيْءَ” (*fassalash shaiyi*): to distinguish different parts of a thing.
- “فَصَّلَ الْكَلَامَ” (*fassalal-kalaam*): “made the sayings clear” or “made it very clear” {M}.

“فَصِيلَةُ الرَّجُلِ” (*fasseelatur rajul*): family {*T, R*} (70:13).
 “فَصَلَ مِنَ الْبَلَدِ” (*fasala minal-balad*): he left the city, or parted with it (2:249).

It is sometimes said that the Quran is “تَفْصِيلُ الْكِتَابِ” (*tafseelal-kitaab*) in (10:37), as well as that it is “الْكِتَابُ مُفَصَّلًا” (*al-kitaab mufassila*) (6:115). Generally tafseel is taken to mean details. That is why when the Quran is said to be “مُفَصَّلٌ” (*mufasssil*), it is taken to mean that it has all the details. As seen earlier, tafseel means clarification and hence “مُفَصَّلٌ” (*mufasssil*) would mean making things clear. That is, in which everything is related clearly and separately {Ibn Qateebah}

The Quran is a clear and simple book to understand (54:17) and has no ambiguity or confusion, but it does not contain the details about everything. Except some injunctions, it has outlines the permanent values which are unchangeable for all times. The further details of these values will be worked out according to the times by the group or party of the believers with mutual consultation for implementing the Quranic system as a model. With the changing times, these details will also change but the basic values will remain the same.

This is “الَّذِينَ الْقِيَمُ” (*ad-deenul qayyim*) i.e. the Deen as quoted in (30:30) and these are the permanent values “كُتُبٌ قَيِّمَةٌ” (*kutubun qayyimah*) contained within the Quran as a book as referred in (98:3).

“تَفْصِيلٌ” (*tafseel*): definition and explanation.

“مُفَصَّلٌ” (*mufasssil*): clear and explicit, distinct and unambiguous, i.e. such that it has the details of all the permanent values required for a balanced human living.

F-Sd-M ف ص م

“فَصَمَ” (*fasam*): to break something, but in a way that it is still joined.

Abi Abeer says this means to snap but not break away altogether.

“الْفَصْمُ” (*al-fasm*): to break into pieces.

“الْفَقْمُ” (*infasm*): was broken or cut:

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says that the belief in Allah is a belief on a dependable law which:

2:256	Which can never crack, leave alone break. It can be depended upon completely.	لَا انْفِصَامَ لَهَا
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F-Zd-H ف ض ح

“الْأَفْضَحُ” (*al-afzah*): a white thing whose whiteness is not intense.

“أَفْضَحَ الصُّبْحُ” (*afzahas subh*): the morning became clear.

“الْفَضْحُ” (*al-fazahu*): the morning itself.

“فَضَحَهُ فَضْحًا” (*fazahahu fazha*): to reveal someone's faults.

“إِفْضَحَ” (*iftazah*): infamous for some deed, or for one's faults to become open or known {*T, M*}.

“الْفَضِيحَةُ” (*al-fazeedah*): to give something a bad name

The Quran says:

15:68	Do not give me a bad name	فَلَا تَفْضَحُونِ
15:69	Do not make me ashamed	لَا تُخْزُونِ

“الْفَضُّ” (*al-fazz*): to scatter, to disperse after congregating or to break into pieces.
 “اِنْفَضَّ” (*itfazz*): to scatter after breaking, or to become different.
 “فَضٌّ مِّنَ النَّاسِ” (*fazzun minan naas*): from among different people {T}.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:158	They would have scattered around you (would have left you)	لَا تَفْضُوا مِنْ حَوْلِكَ
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Surah *Al-Jumah* says:

62:11	(After leaving the congregation) they get attracted towards other things.	اِنْفَضُّوا إِلَيْهَا
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“فِضَّةٌ” (*fizzah*): silver (3:13).
 “فَضَّضَ الشَّيْءَ” (*fazzaz shaiyi*): silver plated a thing.

“الْفَضْلُ” (*al-fazl*): it is the opposite of fault.

Raghib says “فَضْلٌ” (*fazl*) means for something to be more than average.

“فَضْلٌ” (*fazl*) is generally used to denote the good things.
 “فُضُولٌ” (*fuzul*): bad or useless things.
 “الْفَضِيلَةُ” (*al-fazeelah*): high rank or loftiness. It is the opposite of “نَقِيصَةٌ” (*naqeezah*), or profusion of goodness.
 “تَفَضَّلَ عَلَيْهِ” (*tafazzalu alaih*): he excelled him in superiority, favoured him and gave him from his excess wealth.
 “فَوَاضِلُ الْمَالِ” (*fawadilul maal*): the profit of wealth or possession, for instance the produce of the land, the rent for the animals’ lending, their milk or wool etc. {T}.

In the Quran this root has come to mean “to give an edge in the good things”:

2:47	granted you superiority over your contemporary nations	وَفَضَّلْنَاكُمْ عَلَى الْعَالَمِينَ
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For the Messenger to be granted the revelation is called “فَضْلٌ” (*fazal*) in (2:90), but generally this root has appeared to mean well-being:

16:14	the good earning for a living	لِتَبْتَغُوا مِنْ فَضْلِهِ
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The victories in the battle field have also been called “فَضْلٌ” (*fazal*) as in (3:173). It has also appeared opposite of difficulties and unhelpful conditions (4:72-73), as well as against “فَحْشَاءٌ” (*fahsha’u*) i.e. against miserliness (2:268).

As such “فَضْلٌ” (*fazal*) generally means wellbeing and happiness of life which the *momineen* have been instructed to acquire (62:10).

Surah *Bani Israel’s* verse (17:18-21) has explained its meaning clearly, and after pointing to different nations which are following different paths, it is said:

17:18	See how We have granted wellbeing to nations against other nations	أَنْظُرْ كَيْفَ فَضَّلْنَا بَعْضَهُمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ
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This is the commonly taken meaning. The special meaning is any benevolence which man receives from God, including the revelation, it is the greatest benefit that has been granted to man. All national distinct factors and special positions are benefits received from God. To be in a prominent position compared to other nations is also a beneficence of God (2:47).

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:71	As far as earning a living is concerned, Allah has granted every man with distinct capability	وَاللَّهُ فَضَّلَ بَعْضُكُمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ فِي الرِّزْقِ
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But this does not mean that those who have been endowed with more earning capability should take it granted that they can earn as much as they like, and that nobody else has a share in it.

16:71	People who have been granted more earning capacity do not share their wealth with the weaker ones in their society because they do not want to bring them to their level	فَمَا الَّذِينَ فَضَّلْنَا بِرَأْدِي رِزْقِهِمْ عَلَى مَا مَلَكَتْ أَيْمَانُهُمْ فَهُمْ فِيهِ سَوَاءٌ
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These people have been called “أَفَابِنِ اللَّهِ يَجْحَدُونَ” (*afabini’matillahi yajhaddoon*) in (16:71). These people deny the benevolence they have been endowed with by God. That is, the earning capacity has been received from God without any cost or effort, but these people deny this fact.

This verse and other such verses as (41:10), (56:63-73), (43:32), (16:53) are the basis of the Quranic economic system. According to this system every man has the right only to the extent of his labour i.e. reward is for the work. The *momins* are bound by duty to strive their utmost, and whatever more than their needs, must be made available for others.

Details of these matters can be found in the book titled The Quranic System of Sustenance.

F-Zd-W ف ض و

- “أَفْضَاءُ” (*al-faza’u*): porch, vast land, vast place {T}.
- “أَفْضَاءُ” (*al-fizaa’u*): water flowing or spilled on the ground {T}.
- “أَفْضَى فُلَانٌ إِلَى فُلَانٍ” (*afza fulanun ila fulaan*): a man reached to meet another man.
- “أَفْضَى الرَّجُلُ إِلَى الْمَرْأَةِ” (*afzar rujulu ilal-mmar’ah*): to have sex with a woman.
- “الْإِفْضَاءُ” (*al-ifzaa’u*): to reach the end. It also points to having sex {T}.
- “وَقَدْ أَفْضَى بَعْضُكُمْ إِلَى بَعْضٍ” (*waqad afza-u zukum ila baaz*): you have been meeting each other freely (4:21)

F-Te-R ف ط ر

“أَفْطَرُ” (*al-fatr*): tear asunder, to tear apart the first time- for the first time is included in the connotation.

Ibn Abbas has quoted saying that he did not know what the true meaning of the verse (6:14) “فَاطِرَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ” (*faatiris samawaati wal-ard*) was till two Arabs came to him who were quarrelling among each other over a well. One of them said that I had started digging the well first as noted next in Arabic and used term with this root.

“أَنَا فَطَرْتُهَا” (*ana fatartuha*): I had begun to dig this well.

“أَفْطَرُ” (*afatar*): to do something for first time.

Ibnul Airaabi says “أَنَا أَوَّلُ مَنْ فَطَرَ بَدَأَ” (*ana awwalu mun fatara haaza*) means “I am the first man to begin this digging” {T}. Therefore “فَاطِرَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ” (*faatiris samawaati wal-ard*) means “God is the first to have created the universe” (6:14). He has also been called “بَدِيعَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ” (*badee-us samawati wal-ard*) in (6:102).

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:51	Created you for the very first time	فَطَرَكُمْ أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ
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Thus this also explains the former verse

“فِطْرَةٌ” (*fitrah*): the universe that has been created by God, the law or technique according to which He first created the universe, or began the creation of the universe.

One misunderstanding must be removed here. Usually “فِطْرَةٌ” (*fitrat*) is taken to mean nature, like human nature. This is taken to mean the characteristics which are naturally inherent in man from the time of birth, and which cannot be changed. However, this meaning of this root is a later development. When the Greek philosophy got translated into Arabic, then the term nature got introduced as well. This word i.e. nature got translated as *fitrat* and thus it acquired the same meaning.

The term Nature also has two interpretations. One is meaning is related to the laws that are operating in the universe. These are called the Laws of Nature. These laws are immutable and inherent in everything. For example the nature of water is to flow downwards on a slope. This meaning of the nature is fine. Instinct too is taken to mean nature because that too is unchangeable. A sheep eats grass and a lion eats meat. As human beings we have a physical self which like animals has the characteristics e.g. needing food, water, sleep, gets sick and also has death, etc. The physical body is like animals similar to other mammals and follows the same laws. We can call it natural as this follows the natural laws as applicable to other mammals. But this becomes objectionable when the *fitrat* of man himself is considered and called nature.

It is sometimes said that man has been created in accordance with God’s *fitrat*, i.e. God’s nature) and that every child is born according to this. Islam is a *Deen* according to the same *fitrat* and it is said that if a child is protected completely from external influences, and then he will spend his life according to Islam. This concept is completely wrong. If a child is left alone in a jungle where there is no human being then he will grow up like a wild animal. This essentially means if a child is left at its own, it will grow up as an animal.

The Quran has referred to many limitations of human beings (without the Divine Guidance) and these characteristics cannot be considered as “فطرت الله” (*fitratullah*). This is true of the human being who do not follows the revelation and instead follow their own desires.

Following are some of the verses from the Quran about human beings:

70:20	a human being is very impatient and dissatisfied. It is very difficult, nearly impossible to satisfy him	إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ خُلِقَ هَلُوعًا
33:72	is very unaware and oppressive	إِنَّهُ كَانَ ظَلُومًا جَهُولًا
80:17	is very ungrateful	فَبِلِئَالِ الْإِنْسَانِ مَا أَكْفَرُهُ
17:11	is very hasty	وَكَانَ الْإِنْسَانُ عَجُولًا
18:54	keeps quarrelling in most things	وَكَانَ الْإِنْسَانُ أَكْثَرَشَيْءٍ جَدَلًا
36:78	is very quarrelsome	فَإِذَا هُوَ خَصِيمٌ مُبِينٌ

If God had created man in His own image then this is definitely not a good image of His creation. The Quran does not say that man has been created in God’s image. This is taken from an age old false belief according to which it is said, ‘God created man in His own image’.

Based on this wrong concept it is also quoted that there is something in a man which tells him what is wrong and what is right. It is referred as human conscience. This concept too is wrong. There is nothing inside a man which tells him what is absolute right and what is absolute wrong. If there was such a force within a man, then there was no need for any guidance. Any inside guidance would have gone against the freedom to choose available to each one of us as human beings. Animals are pre-programmed to their behaviour and duties and hence cannot be held responsible for what they do. We cannot charge a bear for wounding a human being. In the case of man the external guidance is available in the form of the revelation which used to come through a messenger of God. The last completed message for all times has been revealed in the Quran and there are no more messengers required from God. This means that the Quran has the guidance as an external entity for human beings as a choice – indeed the Quran has explained both the paths (Right & Wrong) and their consequences very clearly. The Quran deals with the

human thought process and the inner self in relation to the higher purpose of life and invites man to the permanent values. It explains the purpose of the human creation (45:21) and holds man responsible for his thoughts and deeds (82:5).

17:11	instead of calling out to righteousness, he beckons evil	يَدْعُ الْإِنْسَانَ بِالشَّرِّ دُعَاءُهُ بِالْخَيْرِ
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If man was endowed inherently with the ability to judge what is wrong and right, then he would not do so. He would not have the right to choose in the first place, like the animals that cannot follow any path other than the one ordained for them. More details can be found in the heading **(L-He-M)**. As such it is wrong to believe that God has created man after His own *fitrat* and that Islam is the *Deen* of *fitrat*. Therefore if man is left to his own desires then he will not follow Islam as revealed in the Quran.

Let us come back to the verse which is taken to mean that God has created man after His own *fitrat*. We have already seen that in the Arabic language in which the Quran has been revealed, the word *fitrah* means the law or method according to which a thing is created for the first time.

Allah is “فَاطِرُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ” (*faatiris samawati fil ard*). Hence “فطرت الله” (*fitrat Allah*) means Allah’s technique or law of creation.

30:30	He created the universe according to a law, so did He create man according to a certain law – this the <i>Deen</i> as an established system	فَطَرَتِ اللَّهُ الَّذِي فَطَرَ النَّاسَ عَلَيْهَا لَا تَبْدِيلَ لِخَلْقِ اللَّهِ - ذَلِكَ الدِّينُ الْقَيِّمُ
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There is no change in this Law of creation. This is further noted in the following verse:

30:30	So face yourself towards the upright way of life	فَأَقِمْ وَجْهَكَ لِلدِّينِ حَنِيفًا
30:31	Therefore guard the laws of God and establish the system of <i>salaat</i> , and do not be from among the <i>mushrikeen</i> .	مُتَّبِعِينَ إِلَيْهِ وَ التَّقْوَى وَأَقِمُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَلَا تَكُونُوا مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ

Aside from the animalistic instincts that man has, there are no unchanging characteristics in man. He has to seek his guidance from the revelation as he has no inbuilt guidance which can guide him to the path of self-development. He has been given the right to accept the guidance or reject it, or adopt any other way of life. This capacity to choose has only been given to man, none else in this world. By virtue of being human every individual shares this right i.e. it is not that some have it and some do not. But this characteristic has been endowed in a latent form (un-developed) which can be developed. This is the special form that God has given man and there is no change in it. If man had some ‘*fitrat*’ that was inbuilt, then he would not have been given the right to choose. In the universe everything has a *fitrat* except man and they cannot deviate from that and have no ability to choose i.e. they don’t have any option. Since man has the right to choose, he has no *fitrat*. A man has a lot of latent potentials in him to develop which is the purpose of his life on this planet. Details of this can be found in the book titled “*Letters to Saleem*”.

We have seen that *fatar* means to dig, tear apart. The Quran says:

82:1	when the sky will tear apart	إِذَا السَّمَاءُ انْفَطَرَتْ
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Also see (19:90)

“مُنْفَطِرٌ” (*munfatir*): that which will tear apart (73:18).

“فُطُورٌ” (*futoor*): gap, faults, blemishes (67:4).

“الْفُظُّ” (*al-fuzz*): the water that the camel stores in his body. When traveling in the desert, water was not available and there was danger of someone dying of thirst, then a camel was torn apart and this stored water was obtained. This water was drunk on compulsion and when forced to. Therefore this word came to be used for a man with whom one did not associate willingly or happily but due to some need or some compulsion. Later this word came to mean a short tempered, harsh man.

“إِفْتَظَّ الرَّجُلُ” (*iftazzar rajul*): he made the camel drink and then bound his mouth with rope so that it couldn't graze, and then when he did not find water in his travel, cut the camel's stomach and drank this water {T, R}.

The Quran says about the messenger that he is kind to his companions “لَيَنْتَ لَهُمْ” (*linta lahum*) and not “فَظًّا” (*fazza*) (3:158). This is how a leader should be, so that people are attracted to him and consider him their brother and best advisor, not one who may cut open the stomach of his beloved camel to get a drink.

Muheet says that “الْفُظُّ” (*al-fooz*) is a man who is very harsh, short tempered, heartless, and harsh in his speech, but also a coward of the sort who is even fearful at places where one should not be

Ibn Faris says it basically means to dislike and abhorrence.

“فَعِلٌ” (*fa'il*): for a man to move, and the means to do something.

Scholars have debated at length in defining “فَعِلٌ” (*fa'il*) and in explaining the difference between “صَنَعَ” (*sana'a*) and “فَعِلٌ” (*fa'il*)

Saghaani has said it means to bring something into being.

Al-Mohkam says that it is used for every act and work.

Ibnul Kamal says it means the effect on someone who exercises the effect on something {T}.

Raghib says it means to have some effect, i.e. either a good or bad effect, intentionally or unintentionally, humans, animals, plants are all included in it. He says this is also the meaning of “عَمَلٌ” (*amal*) and “صَنَعَ” (*sana'a*) is a little more than this {R}.

Muheet says “عَمَلٌ” (*amal*) is something which is done intentionally and with knowledge, but in “فَعِلٌ” (*fa'il*) this is not so. “عَمَلٌ” (*amal*) is work which continues for a long time, but “فَعِلٌ” (*fa'il*) would be said even if the act or work is done one time only. See the heading (*Ain-M-L*).

But this can't be the rule because the Quran has used “فَعِلٌ” (*fa'il*) for Allah, not “عَمَلٌ” (*amal*), and Allah's every act is intentional and with knowledge, and many of his acts have permanence as well. Therefore what the scholars say about “فَعِلٌ” (*fa'il*) could be right as far as humans are concerned, but not for Allah.

“مَنْ فَعَلَ” (*mun fa'al*): who did this? (21:59).

“فَعِلٌ” (*fa'il*): work or deed (21:73).

“فَعَلَةٌ” (*fa'latun*): a single act, to work once (26:19).

“فَاعِلٌ” (*faa'il*): one who acts (18:23).

“فَعَّالٌ” (*fa'aal*): one who does a lot, great worker (11:107).

“كَانَ مَفْعُولًا” (*kaana maf-oola*): that which has been done, which has been completed (8:44).

The Quran has used it so profusely that it is not possible to recount all of the instances here, nor is that necessary. The meaning of this root is evident at the places it has appeared. There is no complication in its meaning and does not require further clarification.

“فَقَدَ” (*faqad*), “يَفْقِدُ” (*yafqid*), “فَقْدًا” (*faqda*): to make something disappear {T}.

Raghib has differentiated between “فَقَدَ” (*faqad*) and “عَدَمَ” (*adum*) by saying that “فَقَدَ” (*faqad*) means for something to disappear after existing but “عَدَمَ” (*adum*) means “فَقَدَ” (*faqad*) as well as for something to be non-existent altogether {R}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:74	What have you lost?	مَاذَا تَفْقِدُ
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“اِفْتَقَدَ” (*iftaqada*) and “تَفَقَّدَ” (*tafaqqad*): to search for something that is lost.

Raghib says that “اِتَّفَقَّدَ” (*at-tafaqqad*) means to find out that something is missing {T}.

Lissan-ul-Arb says that it means to search for something, or to demand something which has been lost.

Surah *An-Nahal* relates about *Suleman*:

27:20	<i>Suleman</i> called for riders of fast horses (who were not present there at that time)	وَتَفَقَّدَ الطَّيْرَ
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See heading (*Te-Y-R*).

“اَلْفَقْرَةُ” (*al-fiqrah*): one vertebra of the spinal cord:

“اَلْفَقِيرُ” (*al-faqeer*): a man with a broken spine, weakling.

“اَلْفَقِيرُ” (*al-faqeer*): the dugout hole in which a date palm is planted {T}.

“فَقِيرٌ” (*faqeer*): any well or ditch in which water accumulates.

“اَلْفَقْرُ” (*al-faqr*), “اَلتَّفْقِيرُ” (*at-tafqeer*): to dig a hole. It also means to punch holes in pearls or to pierce a camel's nose in order to rein it {T}. Such a camel is called “اَلْفَقِيرُ” (*al-faqeer*) {T}.

These meanings explain the difference between “فَقْرٌ” (*faqr*) and “فَقِيرٌ” (*faqeer*).

The Quran has used the words “فُقَرَاءُ” (*fuqara'a*) and “مَسَاكِينُ” (*masakeen*) separately (9:60) due to which scholars have tried to differentiate between them, but nobody could draw a clear line between them. Generally it has been said that a “فَقِيرٌ” (*faqir*) is one who has something but not enough to meet his needs. The plural is “فُقَرَاءُ” (*fuqara'a*), but a “مَسْكِينٌ” (*miskeen*) is one who has nothing at all. For the meaning of “مَسْكِينٌ” (*miskeen*) see heading (*S-K-N*). It has also been written that some people call the needy as “فَقِيرٌ” (*faqir*) but a foreigner who comes and settles in an Islamic state and is also needy, is called a “مَسْكِينٌ” (*miskeen*).

The Quran has used the word “فَقْرٌ” (*faqr*) against “غَنَى” (*ghani*) in (3:180) and (2:273). For the meaning of “غَنَى” (*ghani*) see heading (*Gh-Ain-N-Y*). Thus “فَقْرٌ” (*faqr*) would mean need or for the need to remain unfulfilled, i.e. the “فُقَرَاءُ” (*fuqara'a*) are those people in a society who despite their hard work cannot earn enough to meet their needs (24:32). “فَقْرٌ” (*faqr*) does not only mean physical needs but also the lack of means which are necessary for development of one's personality.

Moosa had told God that:

28:24	Whatever good you have sent towards me is needed by me	إِنِّي لِمَا أَنْزَلْتَ إِلَيَّ مِنْ خَيْرٍ فَقِيرٌ
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This includes both physical means and the means of development. This means that for completion of his personality every man needs the benevolence of God (59:19):

55:29	Everything in the universe needs him	يَسْأَلُهُ مَنْ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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In other words, His benevolence is needed by everything.

In surah *Al-Faatir* the entire mankind has been told that:

35:15	All of you need the benevolence of Allah, and Allah does not need you for any thing	أَنْتُمْ الْمُقْرَأُونَ إِلَى اللَّهِ - وَاللَّهُ هُوَ الْغَنِيُّ الْحَمِيدُ
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For the physical things man needs the means provided by nature, and for the self-development man needs the guidance of the revelation.

In a Quranic society the “فُقَرَاءُ” (*fuqa’ra*) would be those who despite their best efforts cannot produce enough to meet their needs and society would be responsible for fulfilling their needs. This will be initial stages of the establishment of the system. Gradually, once the system is established the environment will be provided which will fulfil both physical needs the needs for the self-development. Since all their needs will thus be looked after, there would in fact be nobody who will be needy. They will be “فَقِيرٌ” (*faqeer*) or needy only till a full Quranic society comes into being. One should note here that since the self-development is related to the inner change, this will still depend on the individual choice whether to accept Allah as a model or to accept others as models. However, as a human being all basic needs will be met and the environment will be conducive for the self-development. The opportunities will be there for the self-development through education, training and gaining application as noted in (62:2).

“فَقَارَةٌ” (*faaqirah*): misery which can break one’s back (75:25).

F-Q-Ain ف ق ع

“فَاقِعٌ” (*faaqih*): every hard or fast colour or pure and unadulterated colour {T}. In the Quran this word has appeared with the word “صَفْرَاءُ” (*safra’a*) in (2:69) which means dark yellow.

Ibn Faris says that the meaning of this root does not appear according to any rule.

“فَوَاقِعُ الدَّهْرِ” (*fawaqi-ud dahar*): the miseries of life.

F-Q-He ف ق ه

“أَلْفَقَهُ” (*al-fiqh*): to comprehend and understand something {T}.

The Quran says:

48:15	They understand very little	لَا يَفْقَهُونَ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا
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It means to understand like an animal which understands something instinctively.

“فَحْلٌ فَاقِيَهُ” (*fahlun faqih*): a camel who can understand as to which she-camel is pregnant and which can be copulated with {T}.

Raghib says that a “أَلْفَقَهُ” (*fiqh*) means to conclude that which is unknown through the known. That is to conclude about the abstract truths by comprehending the physical facts {R}, that is, by reflecting on the hard facts of the times and understand as to which laws of the *deen* are applicable to them. This is “تَفَقَّهُ فِي” (*tafaqqahu fid-deen*) as mentioned in (9:122).

The Quran has said that the way to “تَفَقَّهُ فِي الدِّينِ” (*tafaqqahu fid-deen*) is for some people from all walks of life to come to the centre and reach consensus or “تَفَقَّهُ” (*tafaqqah*) about the *Deen*. Then they can go back and tell the others about it (9:122). This “تَفَقَّهُ فِي الدِّينِ” (*tafaqqah fid-deen*) is not the exclusive right of any group. This was the way of “تَفَقَّهُ” (*tafaqqah*) in the early stages of the establishment of the *Deen*. But according to the Quran, deliberation, and “تَفَقَّهُ” (*tafaqqah*) is necessary for all *momins* i.e. believers as defined in the Quran.

“فقه” (*fiqah*) was a legal term meaning to work out sub laws under the guiding principles of the Quran and as per the needs of the time. This was the work for an Islamic system, but now “فقه” (*fiqah*) has come to mean the beliefs of a particular Imam (religious scholar), for instance Imam *Abu Hanifa*, or those “فقهاء” (*fuqaha’a*) who were of the same belief.

It is important to note what the Quran meant by “تَفَقَّهَ فِي الدِّينِ” (*tafaqqah fid-deen*) and what has it now become! When *Deen* instead of a collective system becomes an individual matter then this is what happens!

F-K-R ف ك ر

“فَكَرَ” (*fakar*), “أَفَكَرَ” (*afkaar*), “فَكَّرَ” (*fakkar*), “تَفَكَّرَ فِيهِ” (*tafakkara feeh*): to deliberate on something or in some matter with equanimity according to a pattern and to use one’s observation and intellect and to reach the right conclusion {T}.

Mafardaat says that we can only deliberate on things about which we can have a concept. The things which cannot be conceived cannot be deliberated upon.

That is why it is said:

Reflect upon the things in the universe but do not conjecture about the personality of Allah, one cannot conceive about Him (not required as well)	تَفَكَّرُوا فِي آلَاءِ اللَّهِ وَلَا تَفَكَّرُوا فِي اللَّهِ
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Ibn Faris says that “تَفَكَّرَ” (*tafakkar*) means to turn one’s heart this way and look at the Quran from beginning to end in order to learn a lesson. You will at every step find the invitation to deliberate and reflect. It backs every claim it makes by reasoning and asks you to accept them after due deliberation.

The great stress it puts on deliberation can be gleaned from the fact that it makes the Messenger say:

34:46	tell them that I want to advise you about one thing	قُلْ إِنَّمَا أَعِظُكُمْ بِوَاحِدَةٍ
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The fact that the last messenger has only one thing to say indicates that this one must be very important. The Quran then says that it is not something to be taken lightly:

34:46	Do stand-up before Allah in pairs or as single	أَنْ تَقُومُوا لِلَّهِ مِثْلَىٰ شِئْنَىٰ وَفَرَادَىٰ
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In other words, the first thing that is stressed is not to go on blindly, but stop, wait, and if not all then in one or two. But with only one thought in mind that of Allah alone and no other. And then it is said:

34:46	then think, reflect, deliberate, and reason	ثُمَّ تَتَفَكَّرُوا
34:46	This invitation that is being brought to you is not the result of the messenger’s madness, obsession or fantasy.	مَا بِصَا حِكْمٍ مِنْ جَنَّةٍ

Note how much stress is put on deliberation.

But now the situation is such that thinking and reasoning are almost considered as forbidden for us, when it comes to reflecting in the Quran. Whatever the Quranic verse is, the first question that crops up is what have the elders or the forefathers said about it? If whatever you say is not backed by the elders then you are considered to be creating chaos or being an atheist. So much so that whatever was needed to be thought about the Quran has been done and now we are supposed only to follow all that blindly and not deliberate ourselves, although the call made by the Quran to deliberate was not fixed for any time period, but remains the same for all times.

According to the Quran, just like our elders were supposed to deliberate, and so are we. If we do not deliberate then it is an open disregard or violation of the Quranic guidance, but these days we our religious leaders declare thinking, reflection and reasoning in the Quranic guidance as equivalent to

unbelief. Actually when nations lose the will to act then they consider it safe to follow those who have gone before them blindly. Deliberation itself is an act and requires a lot of energy and labour. Then with deliberation one finds and discovers new ways which again require to be acted upon. A nation which is reluctant to think also abhors action. This is the actual reason for running away from deliberation and action, but man calls it following the elders' path. This is only a lame excuse. For example in the US the critical thinking is part of the school syllabus and this puts the nation far ahead of the rest in the world of science and technology.

The nation which does not do critical thinking falls below the level of humanity as it cannot benefit from the natural and human resources which are meant to be used and the Quran has asked us to bring these into use for the good of all (within the domain of the permanent values). The difference between a man and an animal is that man has been given the faculty to think about thinking (meta-cognition) but an animal has not. We can benefit from the work of our elders in historical context, but we do not become atheist or go out of Islam if in the light of latest knowledge and developments, we do not agree with them. The level of human understanding and knowledge is rising all the time, and therefore every coming generation is ahead of its predecessor. Since the Quran is good for all times i.e. till the last day, it must be deliberated and researched on a continuous basis. It has been noted at various places in the Quran to deliberate, reflect and reason on every matter confronting in our life. By studying the Quran one can find all those places, and one will be able to be aware of the harsh treatment which awaits those who refuse to think and reflect. More details can be found in the headings *(Ain-Q-L)*, *(Ain-L-M)*, *(D-B-R)* and *(Q-L-D)*.

F-K-K

ف ك ك

“فَكَّ” (*fakkah*), “يُفَكُّ” (*yaffukkuhu*), “فَكَّ” (*fakka*): he separated him.

“فَانْفَكَّ” (*fanfak*): so he got separated from him.

“فَكَكْتُ الشَّيْءَ” (*fakatush shaiyi*): I liberated that thing, moved it from its place.

“فَكَّ الْأَسِيرَ” (*fakkal-aseer*): he liberated the prisoner.

“فَكَ يَدَهُ” (*fakka yadah*): he opened his hand, i.e. revealed what he was holding in his palm.

“فَكَّ الْخَتَمَ” (*fakkal-khatam*): he broke the seal {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

90:13	liberate someone	فَكَّ رَقَبَةً
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This value includes all what is involved in freeing the oppressed and to save the downtrodden from oppression. This will also include the prevention and elimination of all causes which lead on to human exploitation directly or indirectly at all levels and tantamount to ‘slavery’.

At another place it is said:

98:1	The people with the book could not be liberated from the self-created shackles of their false beliefs and customs till they had received the revelation	لَمْ يَكُنِ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا مِنْ أَهْلِ الْكِتَابِ وَالْمُشْرِكِينَ مُنْفَكِّينَ حَتَّى تَأْتِيَهُمُ الْبَيِّنَةُ
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That is why it is said about the messenger:

7:157	He has come to free mankind from the burdens it had imposed on itself (or the shackles it had bound itself with) (<i>i.e. anyone without the revelation will be bound by the self-created chains</i>)	وَيَضَعُ عَنْهُمْ إِصْرَهُمْ وَالْأَغْلَالَ الَّتِي كَانَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ
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The purpose of the Quran is to liberate mankind from all types of physical and mental bondages, and the messenger of Allah did help people to do so. But after his death we collected all the shackles that he had helped his companions to break and put them around our own necks voluntarily. Now we are troubled by these shackles as these have hampered our self-development, but at the same time these have become so sacrosanct that it is very difficult for anyone to get rid of them – because we do not think and reflect in the Quran. Only the Quran can help us to break those shackles but we do not want to refer to the Quran, so here we are – and this all is happening in the presence of Allah!

“فَكِيهَ الرَّجُلِ” (*fakihar rajul*): he became cheerful, and full of good humour. Such a man who possesses these qualities will be called “فَكِيهٌ” (*fakihun*) or “فَاكِهٌ” (*faakihah*).

“أَلْفَاكِهَةٌ” (*al-faakihah*): any kind of fruit. The plural is “فَوَاكِهٌ” (*fawakihah*) as in (23:19).

“أَلْفُكَايَةٌ” (*al-fukahah*): cheerful talk, good humour.

“فَاكِهَةٌ” (*faakaha*), “مُفَاكِهَةٌ” (*mufaakahah*): one joked with another {T}.

The Quran speaks about the dwellers of the paradise:

31:55	they will be cheerfully engaged (will converse with each other very cheerfully, or be full of happiness)	فِي شُغْلٍ مُكِينٍ
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Ibn Faris has said that “أَلْمُفَاكِهَةُ” (*al-mufaakkahah*) means cheerfulness.

“تَفَكَّهَ مِنْ كَذَا” (*tafakkahu min kaza*): he was surprised at that.

“تَفَكَّهَ الرَّجُلُ” (*tafakkahur rajul*): he was ashamed {T, R}.

“أَلْأَفْكُوهُ” (*al-ufkuhuha*): a surprising thing, humorous thing.

Surah *Al-Waaqiha* says:

56:65	you will be surprised	فَطَلَّيْتُمْ تَفَكُّهُونَ
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Ibn Faris says that in the Arabic language, initially this word was “تَفَكَّنُونُ” (*tafakkanoon*) but later the “ن” (N) was replaced by “ه” (He) and it became “تَفَكَّهُونُ” (*tafakkahoon*).

“تَفَكَّنُونُ” (*tafakkanoon*): to be ashamed.

“أَلْفَاكِهٌ” (*al-faakihu*): one who is vain {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

83:31	return in vanity or while preening	إِنْقَلَبُوا فَكِهِينَ
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“فَلَّحَ” (*falaha*): to tear apart, to make a gap.

“فَلَّاحٌ” (*fallah*): a farmer because he tills the soil and thus tears it apart to get it ready for sowing {T, M, R}.

“فَلَّاحَةٌ” (*fallahah*): cultivator and to cultivate {T}.

Since the return or compensation of a “فَلَّاحٌ” (*fallahun*) or farmer’s labour is that for each seed he sows he gets hundreds of grains when the crop comes up and matures, thus the word “فَلَّاحٌ” (*falaha*) has come to mean multiplied success and well-being {*Ibn Faris*}.

“مُفْلِحُونَ” (*muflihoon*) are those whose crops grow, whose labour is rewarded, and whose labour meets with success. These are the meanings for which the Quran has used this word.

The *momineen* are said to be:

2:5	These are the people who are successful	أُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُفْلِحُونَ
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By receiving nourishment for the human personality to grow, it is said:

91:10	whoever nourished it (the personality) becomes successful	قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ زَكَّاهَا
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The Quran has not described the result of good deeds by man as “نِجَاتٌ” (*nijaat*) e.g. emancipation, which means to be rid of some misfortune- i.e. equivalent of deliverance from something negative. A man is sitting and some misfortune befalls him, then he strives to get rid of it and after a struggle manages to do

so. Thus the previous state of the man is restored. This entire struggle (to get rid of such misfortune) bore no positive developments for him (that nothing accrued to him). This is a Christian concept which considers man as a sinner from the birth, and for that each child is to be rid of the misery through salvation. Or it is the belief of the Hindus who believe that man is imprisoned in this world in order to atone for the sins of his earlier creation, and to be delivered of this imprisonment is called freedom. The Buddhists also believe in *vaiddaant* which says that the purpose of man's struggle and effort is towards this deliverance, i.e. the human soul (being separate from its reality, i.e. God) is crying out in anguish – and its destiny is to get rid of this agony and meet the whole.

The Quranic belief is that a man comes into this world with a clean slate, and by first accepting and then following the path offered by the revelation his personality is gets developed through the righteous deeds and this process of the self-development is sign posted in the Quran. He attains all the defined happiness in this world and also develops the ability which enables him to move on to the next stage of life called the hereafter. That is why they have been likened to “فَلَّاحُ” (*falaah*). These are positive results, thus they have been likened to “فَلَّاحُ” (*falaah*), i.e. for the crop to grow or for it to be fruitful.

Surah *Baqarah* says that the *momineen* (believers) are those who using their intellect and reasoning have an assured belief and conviction in the unseen results explained in the Quran which can be obtained through the Quranic system (2:3). Then they engage in establishing this system and when the positive results of this system appear before their eyes, their belief on the unseen turns into reality (2:4). They are like a cultivator who sows a seed and works hard for months, and after a known time later the results of his endeavour comes before his eyes through the crops.

Ibn Qateeba says “الْفَلَّاحُ” (*al-falah*) means perpetuity, i.e. to remain stable and stolid, and “مُفْلِحُونَ” (*muflihoon*) means those who enjoy perpetually. Remember that as stated earlier, this means successful life in this world as well as the hereafter (16:97). Therefore “hereafter” means the future life i.e. the life here and in the life to come.

F-L-Q

ف ل ق

“فَلَّقَ الشَّيْءَ” (*falaqash shaiyi*), “يَفْلِقُهُ” (*yafliquhu*) and “فَلَّقَهُ” (*fallaqahu*): he tore up something.

“فَانْفَلَقَ” (*fanfalaqa*): a thing was torn apart {T, M}.

“فَالِقُ الْإِصْبَاحِ” (*faaliqul isbaah*): someone who tears apart the darkness of the night and brings forth the day (6:97).

Zajaaj says it can also mean the Creator

“الْفَلَقُ” (*al-falaq*): morning. *Zajaaj* says it means for the morning to be evident.

It also means creatures, as well as for the truth to be evident after difficulties {T, M}.

113:1	Declare that I seek protection of the Sustainer of the <i>falaq</i>	قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ الْفَلَقِ
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In the universe the evolutionary process is progressing i.e. one thing breaks open and a new thing emerges from it which goes upward and moves ahead and then another thing emerges from it. For example, the bud appears from within the seed, then a branch sprouts, a leaf appears from it then a flower bud, then the flower and then the fruit, then seeds are created in the fruit and then a new system of regeneration begins.

The Quran refers to this process in this verse:

6:96	Allah tears apart the seed. He brings forth life from the dead and brings forth the dead from the living. This is Allah's system of giving life and evolution This is the <i>Rabbil falaq</i> i.e. the God who directs this process (113:1)	إِنَّ اللَّهَ فَالِقُ الْحَبِّ وَالنَّوَى - يُخْرِجُ الْحَيَّ مِنَ الْمَيِّتِ وَيُخْرِجُ الْمَيِّتَ مِنَ الْحَيِّ
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“الْفَلَكَ” (*al-falak*): the big and round part of anything like a sea wave or the circle of stars {*T, F*}.

The Quran says:

36:40	All the heavenly bodies rotate fast in their orbits	كُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ
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“الْفُلْكَ” (*al-fulk*): a boat (16:14). This is both singular and plural and also masculine and feminine {*T, F*}.

“فُلَانٌ” (*fulanun*) and “فُلَانَةٌ” (*fulanah*) is a reference to human names, first for masculine and second for feminine. With “ا” (*alif*) and “ل” (*laam*) as in “الْفُلَانُ” (*al-fulanu*) and “الْفُلَانَةُ” (*al-fulanah*) is used for other things than humans {*T*}.

Muheet says “فُلَانٌ” (*fulanun*) and “فُلَانَةٌ” (*fulanah*) is used to refer to human names or beings with intellect. For those without intellect “فُلَانًا” (*fulaana*) is used {*M*}.

The Quran says:

25:28	O my misfortune, I wish I had not befriended that man	يَا وَيْلَتَى لَيْتَنِي لَمْ أَتَّخِذْ فُلَانًا خَلِيلًا
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Zajaaj says here “فُلَانًا” (*fulanun*) means *shaitaan* because it is said ahead:

25:29	And at last the <i>shaitaan</i> leaves man's side	وَكَانَ الشَّيْطَانُ لِلْإِنْسَانِ خَذُولًا
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As it has been explained in the chapter about *shaitaan*, under the heading (*Sh-Te-N*), every wicked one is *shaitaan* and therefore here it refers to the friendship with the wicked ones.

“الْفَنَدُ” (*al-fanad*): to become old, or to become senile, or to make a wrong judgement when expressing some opinion {*T*}.

Lissan-ul-Arb says “فَنَدٌ” (*fanad*) means lies {*T*}.

Raghib says it means weakness of judgement or erroneous opinion {*R*}.

“فَنَدَهُ” (*fannadahu*): made him out to be a liar, with weak opinion or senile.

“أَفَنَدَ” (*afnad*): he lied.

“قَدْ أَفَنَدَ” (*qad afnad*): is said when an old man becomes very old, because then he talks away from what is right. Such a woman is not called “مُفْنِدَةٌ” (*mufnidah*) because in the opinion of the Arabs, they are not too strong intellectually even when they are not too old.

Raghib says that when a man talks too much due to old age, he is called “مُفْنِدٌ” (*mufnid*).

Ibn Faris says it means to be heavy and hard, as well as old age with entailing senility.

Surah Yusuf says that *Yaqaob* told his people:

12:94	If you stop saying about me that due to old age I have become senile and talk nonsense ...	لَوْلَا أَن تُمَنَّدُونَ
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“الْفُنُّ” (*al-funn*) with its plurals forms “فُنُونٌ” (*funoon*) and “أَفْنَانٌ” (*afnaan*) means state, kind, type or surprising matter.

“الْفُنَّ” (*al-funan*): that branch which has fresh leaves. Plurals are “أَفْنَانٌ” (*afnaan*) and “أَفَانِينُ” (*afaneen*).

“الْفُنُونُ” (*alfunoon*): mixed people of different tribes.

“رَجُلٌ مِفْنٌ” (*rajulun mifunn*): a man who does surprising things.

“أَفَانِينُ الْكَلَامِ” (*afaneenul kalaam*): different kinds and styles of speech. It also means knowledge and arts {T, R}.

The Quran says that *jannat* has “ذَوَاتَا أَفْنَانٍ” (*zawata afnaan*) which means “different branches” (55:48). In other words, *jannat* is a place where different sciences and art forms are commonly found. According to the Quran one characteristic of the heavenly society is also that it would be the centre of various knowledge and arts.

“الْفَنَاءُ” (*al-fana'u*): opposite of “بَقَاءٌ” (*baqaa*), which means for something to stay in its own condition. See heading (B-Q-Y). Hence this word means for something to be without change.

“الْفَنَاءُ” (*alfana'u*): for changes to appear in something, or for it to not stay in its original condition and for changes to continue to take place in it.

The Quran says:

55:26	Everything on it is in flux	كُلُّ مِمَّنْ عَلَيْهَا تَابٍ
55:27	But the Sustainer remains unchanged	وَيَبْقَىٰ وَجْهُ رَبِّكَ ذُو الْجَلَالِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ

“فَانٍ” (*faanin*) is a noun verb. It does not mean that a time will come when everything on the earth will disappear and only God will remain. It means that everything there is on the earth undergoes change but God's personality does not, and He remains constant. “Change” is not really a change in the thing. What happens is that one thing disappears and a new thing appears in its place, but both these things happen in such a subtle manner that it cannot be felt as to when one thing disappears and another thing replaces it.

Beregson has treated this point in detail. He says that personality is a thing in which changes do take place but it never disappears and never ceases to exist. This is what **Bordave** has described it as changelessness in change. Since God's personality is a complete one, there is no question for it to disappear and reform or be replaced. Our philosophy has reached only this far, but it too throws some light on the verses (55:25-26). But since the thing which undergoes change is replaced by the thing which replaces it therefore “الْفَنَاءُ” (*al-fana'u*) can be said at the time when something ends.

“الْفَانِي” (*al-faani*): a very old man who is near the end i.e. death.

“فَنَاءُ الدَّارِ” (*fina-ud daar*): vast ground in front of a house because this is where boundary of a house ends {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says the meanings of this word are not according to any rule.

“فَهْمٌ” (*fahim*), “يَفْهَمُ” (*yafham*), “فَهْمًا” (*fahma*): to comprehend something profoundly.

Some say the difference between knowledge and comprehension i.e. between “علم” (*ilm*) and “فَهْمٌ” (*faham*) is that “علم” (*ilm*) means complete understanding, but “فَهْمٌ” (*faham*) is for the mind to deliberate on the signs of the outer world and then changing direction to other things.

Others say that the concept that comes to mind when one hears words is “فَهْمٌ” (*faham*). Still others say that “فَهْمٌ” (*faham*) is that quality of mind with which it comprehends the meaning {T, R}.

“فَهَّمْتُهُ” (*fahamtu*): I made him understand {T, R}.

The Quran says:

21:79	We made <i>Suleman</i> understand the matter	فَهَّمْنَاهَا سُلَيْمَانَ
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“فَاتَاهُ الْأَمْرُ” (*faatahul amr*): the matter went out of his hands, went out of his hands, or went out of his reach {T}. (3:152).

“فَاتَاهُ الْأَمْرُ” (*faatahul amr*): the time for doing that deed passed {T}.

“الْفَوْتُ” (*al-faut*): for something to go so far out of man’s reach that it is difficult to reach it (34:52).

The saying is:

that can be seen by him but is out of his reach	هُوَ قَوْتٌ فِيهِ أَوْ قَوْتٌ رُجِي
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“الْفَوْتُ” (*al-faut*): gap, breach. It also means the space between two fingers {T}.

“تَفَاوُتٌ” (*tafawut*): lack of co-ordination and lack of proportion {M}.

Surah *Al-Mulk* says:

67:3	You will not find any absence of balance in the universe created by God (everywhere therein is proportion and balance)	مَا تَرَىٰ فِي خَلْقِ الرَّحْمَنِ مِن تَفَوتٍ
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“الْفَوْجُ” (*al-fauj*), “الْفَاجِئُ” (*al-faa-ij*): a group or party of people, followers of the rich.

Plural is “أَفْوَاجٌ” (*afwaaaj*).

Ibn Faris says it basically means to gather and collect.

“أَفَاجٌ” (*afaaj*): he became speedy.

“فَاجِ الْمِسْكِ” (*faajal-misk*): the perfume of the musk spread.

“الْفَوْجُ” (*al-fauj*): an army which passes by with speed {T, M, R}

The Quran says:

27:83	That day or time when We will gather one group from every party	يَوْمَ نَحْشُرُ مِنْ كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ فَوْجًا
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Here this word means speed and profusion as well. One stage of the establishment of *Deen* is that in which a person or two enter the *Deen* after great travails by the messenger. Then due to their struggle a group is formed which accepts their *Deen*. This is the fore runner group which faces innumerable travails.

But after the initial struggle gradually people after seeing the benefits of this system, they start to enter this system in groups. This is the stage which is said to be:

110:2	Enter the Deen of Allah in groups.	يَدْخُلُونَ فِي دِينِ اللَّهِ أَفْوَاجًا
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F-W-R

ف و ر

“فَارَ” (**faar**) and “فَوْرًا” (**faura**): to break out, or gush forth.

“فَارَتِ الْقَدْرُ” (**faaratil qadr**): the pot started to boil.

“الْفَوَارَةُ” (**al-fawwarah**): the place from where the spring sprouts forth {T}.

“رَجُلٌ فَيَّورٌ” (**rajulun fayyur**): a short tempered and quickly agitated man {M}.

The Quran says:

11:40	springs sprang forth from the ground with gusto	فَارَاتُ السُّورِ
3:124	they may attack you with all their might and gusto	وَيَأْتِيَنَّكُمْ مِنْ قَوَرٍ هُمْ
67:7	that will be exerting with gusto	وَهِيَ تَمْوَرُ

Ibn Faris says it means with gusto.

“فَوْرٌ” (**faur**): to do something quickly and without delay {T, F}.

In Arabic, it is said “عَلَى الْفَوْرِ” (**ala al-faur**) and in Urdu it is said “فورا” (**fauran**).

F-W-Z

ف و ز

“الْفَوْزُ” (**al-fauz**): to be rid of some misery. Its other meaning is to get what is wanted or desired {T, F}. It also means to be rid of some misery - this is a negative achievement. The Quran says attaining a heavenly life is a positive achievement. The dwellers of **jannat** are therefore called “فَاءِزُونَ” (**faa-izoon**) in (59:20) i.e. those who attain “جَوْ فَازٍ فَوْزًا عَظِيمًا” (**faaza fauzan azeema**) great achievement (33:7). This also includes the blessings of life as the Quran has itself explained in (4:73) i.e. great fulfilment of wishes. At another place it is called “مَفَازٌ” (**mafaaza**) (78:31).

Surah **Aal-e-Imran** says that he who was saved from destruction and entered the **jannat** or heaven:

3:184	is the one who will be called successful	فَقَدْ فَازَ
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To be saved from destruction and to attain the blessings of life is success.

This has been related at another place as:

39:61	God protects the muttaqis from destruction with their success.	يُنَجِّي اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا بِمَفَازِهِمْ
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In other words they are not only able to avoid the destructive forces but they also attain their aims.

World religions say that the purpose of life is to be free of the difficulties that engulf man in life, but the Quran does not say so. It thinks success is avoiding the destruction and reaching one's goal. See headings (**F-L-H**) and (**N-J-W**). This positive success is a life of honour in this world, and the capability of completing more evolutionary stages in the hereafter is what “فوز عظيم” (**fauzil azeem**) is.

”فَوَضَّ إِلَيْهِ الْأَمْرَ تَفْوِضًا“ (*fawwaz ilaihil amra tafweeza*): he referred the matter back to him, or left it to him to decide in the matter {*T, M, R*}.

”الْمُفَاوَضَةُ“ (*al-mufawazah*): to be equal to somebody and to participate.

”مَتَاعُهُمْ فَوْضَى بَيْنَهُمْ“ (*mata-u-hum fauza bainahum*): their spoils of war or goods belong to all of them collectively.

”قَوْمٌ فَوْضَى“ (*qaumun fauza*): a party in which all are equal, or a nation in which there is no leader and all are equal. In other words, it is a nation where nobody orders anybody {*T, M, R*}. It also means those whose matter is ambiguous and not clear. Hence it means those, among whom nobody accepts responsibility, and passes buck to others.

Nowadays ”فَوْضَوِيَّت“ (*fauzawiyyat*) means anarchy.

The Quran says:

40:44	I leave the matter to God (give Him the right to decide)	وَأَفْوضُ أَمْرِي إِلَى اللَّهِ
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Ibn Faris says it basically means “to depend on someone” and “to relinquish it to him”. The group or party of the *momineen* depends on the laws of Allah completely, and by following the Quran they know that all matters will ultimately go in their favour.

”فَوْقُ“ (*fauq*): is the opposite of ”تَحْتَ“ (*tahat*) which means “below”, hence ”فَوْقُ“ (*fauq*) means to be above.

The Quran has also used this word against ”أَسْفَلَ“ (*asfal*) in (33:10).

”فَاقًا“ (*faaqa*), ”فَوْقًا“ (*fauqan*): to be more than someone in some matter.

”فَوْقُ“ (*fauq*) sometimes also means to be lower than something. So when it is said ”فُلَانٌ صَغِيرٌ“ (*fulanun sagheer*) which means “he is small” and in reply it is said ”وَفَوْقَ ذَلِكَ“ (*wa fauqa zaalik*) then here it would mean “even smaller than what you say” {*T, M, R*}. In (2:26) this word has this meaning. Some scholars think that here too this word means “over”.

”أَلْفَاقُ“ (*al-faa'iq*): the best part of anything.

”تَفَوَّقَ عَلَى قَوْمِهِ“ (*tafawwaqa ala qaumihi*): he excelled in rank in his nation.

In the Quran this word has appeared to mean power and control:

16:50	They are afraid of the supremacy of Allah over them	يَخَافُونَ رَبَّهُمْ مِنْ فَوْقِهِمْ
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”إِفَاقَةً“ (*ifaaqah*), ”فَوَاقٍ“ (*fawaq*) and ”فُؤَاقٍ“ (*fuwaaq*): the period between the times when a she camel gives milk, or the resting time when she-camel returns from grazing before milking her {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says the other basic meaning of this word is to return. As such, for milk to return to teats after milking once, is called ”فَوَاقُ النَّاقَةِ“ (*fawaqun naqah*).

The Quran says:

7:143	when he recovered from unconsciousness or swooning (when he was at peace)	فَلَمَّا أَفَاقَ
38:15	there will be no time in between	مَا لَهَا مِنْ فَوَاقٍ

Ibn Faris has said it also means to refer back or return i.e. reiteration and to happen again.

”فُؤَاقٍ“ (*fuwaaq*): hiccup.

“الْفَاقَةُ” (*al-faqah*): need and expectation.
 “اِفْتَقَرَ الرَّجُلُ” (*iftaqar rujul*): that man became needy {*T*}.

F-W-M ف و م

Some think that in “الْفُومُ” (*al-foom*) in fact was “ثُومٌ” (*thom*) but the “ف” (*F*) has replaced “ث” (*Th*) and that this word actually means garlic.

“الْفُومُ” (*al-foom*): wheat as well as bread. It also means all the grains which are used to make bread, like maize etc. Some think “الْفُومُ” (*al-foom*) means chick peas {*T, R*}. In the Quran this word has appeared in (2:61).

F-W-He ف و ه

“فَاهٌ” (*fah*), “فُوهُ” (*fooh*), “فِيهِ” (*feeh*): mouth.

The plural is “أَفْوَاهٌ” (*afwaah*) which means spices and also those ingredients which are added for their flavour or fragrance. Hence it also means different kinds of flowers, buds and herbs or various other kinds of things {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means openness.

Raghib says that at those places where the Quran has said “فَمٌ” (*fum*) or “فُوهُ” (*foh*), it has referred to lies and falsehoods. That is, they only say that and do not mean it.

3:166	they say things which they have no faith in	يَقُولُونَ بِأَفْوَاهِهِمْ مَا لَيْسَ فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ
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Fee فى

“فِي” (*fee*): time or place, like in the mosque, in a few years.

“فَاصْبَحْ فِي الْمَدِينَةِ” (*fa asbaha fil madinah*): so he came to the city in the morning (28:18).

“غَلِبَتِ الرُّومُ... فَيُبْضِعُ سِنِينَ” (*ghulibatir rum...fi baaz-i sineen*): the Romans were overpowered, and after being overpowered they will be in power in a few years’ time again (30:2-4).

This word has the following uses as they appear in the Quran:

2:179	for you there is a life in compensation for unintended death	وَلَكُمْ فِي الْقِصَاصِ حَيَوةٌ
7:38	Tell them to enter along with past nations.	قَالَ ادْخُلُوا فِي أُمَمٍ
12:32	(Governor’s wife said) this is the one for whom you all used to chastise me.	قَالَتْ فَذَلِكُنَّ الَّذِي لُمْتُنَّنِي فِيهِ
20:71	I will put you on a cross of the date palm trunk	وَلَأَصْلَبَنَّهُمْ فِي جَدُوعِ النَّخْلِ
14:9	Then their hands were taken up to their mouths	فَرَدُّوا أَيْدِيَهُمْ فِي أَفْوَاهِهِمْ
16:89	The day We will raise witnesses from every nation.	وَيَوْمَ نَبْعَثُ فِي كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ شَهِيدًا
9:38	the life of this world against the hereafter (<i>aakhirah</i>) is very short	فَمَا مَتَاعُ الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا فِي الْآخِرَةِ إِلَّا قَلِيلٌ
11:41	he said board this boat	قَالَ ارْكَبُوا فِيهَا

“فِي” (*fee*) is redundant because “اِكْبُوْا” (*arkabuha*) also has the same meaning.

Surah *Al-Unkaboot* says:

29:69	Those who make concerted effort to come to Us or towards Our Revelation, We guide them to Our paths	وَالَّذِينَ جَاهَدُوا فِينَا لَنَهْدِيَنَّهُمْ سُبُلَنَا
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“فَيْءٌ” (*fia*): shadow, shade.

Muheet says that the “ظِلٌّ” (*zill*) is the shadow of things created from sunrise to the time when the sun starts setting; and from the time the sun starts to set till sunset, this shadow is called “فَيْءٌ” (*faiyi*).

“فَاءٌ” (*fa’a*): to return or revert.

“أَفَاءٌ” (*afa*): to return or revert.

“فَيْءٌ” (*fai*): to return to the good state.

“فَيْءٌ” (*fia*): booty and tax that is returned.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:48	its shadow keeps reverting to the right and left	يَتَقَبَّضُ ظِلُّهُ عَنِ الْيَمِينِ وَالشَّمَائِلِ
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Surah *Al-Hijraat* says:

49:9	till he reverts to the laws of Allah	حَتَّى تَقْبِىَ إِلَى أَمْرِ اللَّهِ
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The Quran has mentioned “فَيْءٌ” (*fai*) and booty separately. War booty is mentioned in surah *Al-Hashr*:

59:6	And the war booty that Allah granted His messenger, was not due to your efforts (i.e. battle) but Allah is beneficent and gives power His messenger over whom He wishes (i.e. as per His Laws)	وَمَا أَفَاءَ اللَّهُ عَلَى رَسُولِهِ مِنْهُمْ فَمَا أَوْجَفْتُمْ عَلَيْهِ مِنْ خَيْلٍ وَلَا رِكَابٍ وَلَكِنَّ اللَّهَ يُسَلِّطُ رُسُلَهُ عَلَى مَنْ يَشَاءُ---
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It shows that “فَيْءٌ” (*fai*) is booty which is acquired without battle.

It also includes besides the wealth and goods which are acquired from the enemy, which the provinces send to the Centre. About the division of war booty, it is said that it is for Allah and His messenger and for *zil qurbah*, for the orphans and for the needy and for *ibnis sabeel*. After this it is said:

59:7	so that this wealth does not keep circulating only among the rich amongst you	كَئِنْ لَا يَكُونُ ذُوْلَهُ بَيْنَ الْأَغْنِيَاءِ مِنْكُمْ
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This principle denotes a very important and basic point about national wealth, i.e. wealth should not keep circulating among the rich. Afterwards it is said:

59:7	Take what the messenger gives you and abstain from which he bars you	وَمَا آتَاكُمُ الرَّسُولُ فَخُذُوهُ وَمَا نَهَاكُمْ عَنْهُ فَانْتَهُوا
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This shows that while the Quran has given the heads under which this wealth is to be distributed, it gives the right to do so to the central authority which will distribute as required.

About war booty the surah *Al-Anfaal* says:

8:41	And understand that whatever you get as booty has a fifth part for Allah and the messenger and <i>zil Qurba</i> , <i>yatama</i> , <i>masakeen</i> and <i>ibnis sabeel</i> .	وَأَعْلَمُوا أَنَّمَا غَنِمْتُمْ مِنْ شَيْءٍ فَإِنَّ لِلَّهِ خُمُسَهُ وَلِلرَّسُولِ وَلِذِي الْقُرْبَىٰ وَالْيَتَامَىٰ وَالْمَسَاكِينِ وَابْنِ السَّبِيلِ
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About the division of *sadaqaat*, surah *At-Tauba* says that they are to be divided among the needy and those who have very little, and for the workers of the *sadaqaat*, and for liberating those bound in bondage, and for the indebted and misery ridden people and for spending in the way of Allah and for the *ibnis sabeel* (9:60).

About the heads under which war booty can be spent, the book *Ad-dastur-al-Qurani* says that *zil Qurba* does not mean relatives but the people who have been in the forefront of establishing the Islamic system and who have rendered service for the Islamic state. But this gets no confirmation from the Quran although it has confirmed that “ذِي الْقُرْبَىٰ” (*zil qurba*) does not mean prophet’s relatives.

“فَاضَ الْمَاءُ” (*faazal ma-oo*), “يَفِيزُ” (*yafeez*), “فَيْضًا” (*faiza*), “فَيُوزًا” (*fuyuza*): for water to overflow from some place.

It also appears for the tears to flow (5:82).

“حَوْضٌ فَأَيْضٌ” (*hauzun faa iz*): a pool filled to the brim.

“بَحْرٌ فَأَيْضٌ” (*bahrin faaiz*): active sea whose water is almost overflowing.

“الْفَيْضُ” (*al-faiz*): river or canal.

“فَيَّا ض” (*fayyaz*): a canal with abundant water.

“فَاضَ الْمَالُ” (*faazal maal*), “يَفِيزُ” (*yafeez*): the wealth became abundant {T}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this word is to overflow easily. Later this word began to be used for heavy pedestrian traffic.

“الْإِفَاضَةُ” (*al-ifaaza*): for a large number of people to walk, to walk suddenly.

“إِفَاضَةٌ” (*ifaaza*): sudden departure and return. It also means to drift in talk {T}.

“إِفَاضَةٌ” (*ifaaza*) basically means to drop, or let flow (7:50).

To mean “to walk suddenly”, the word has appeared in the Quran in (2:199). It also means “to be carried away in talk” as in (46:8) and “for being engaged in talk” and “to propagate” in (24:14).

“الْفِيلُ” (*al-feel*): elephant {T}.

Some think that this word is the Arabized form of “پیل” (*peel*), and the Arabic origin of word “فِيلُ” (*feel*) means “weakness”.

“رَجُلٌ فَيْلُ الرَّأْيِ” (*rajulun feel-ur-raaee*): a man with weak opinions.

The Quran says:

105:1	Fellowship of elephant.	أَصْحَابُ الْفِيلِ
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History relates that **Abraha Alsharam** (an ancient king) attacked **Ka'ba** with his army of elephants in order to demolish it, and for this he took a secret path in the mountains, but a lot of vultures, expecting food (in the shape of corpses) began to encircle over them and their presence indicated the Quresh of Arabia that some army was coming towards them. So they climbed the mountains around them and ambushed **Abraha's** army by using stones and rocks. Because of this stoning and due to the stampede of the elephants, **Abraha's** army was disturbed and reduced to rubble. Their plot was destroyed and they retreated.

This whole thing has been related in the surah **Al-Feel**. It was an event which the Arabs had seen with their own eyes so they knew what the Quran was relating to. This was a lesson to stop opposing this way of life that is right or else you too will be destroyed.

The Quran relates that **Moosa** was sent towards **Firoun (Pharaoh)**, **Haamaan** and **Qaroon** (40:24). Like the other two, **Qaroon** was also annihilated (29:39). **Qaroon** was from among the nation of **Moosa** but was an embodiment of capitalism. He has been referred with this character failing in the Quran (28:76, 77). The **Torah** says that **Qaroon** or **Farah bin Zahaar bin Qiyaat bin Laavi** rose to challenge **Moosa** (16:1-4). The famous Jewish historian Joseph writes in his book *Antiquity of the Jews*, that:

“**Qaroon**, who was famous both for his (high) breed and for his wealth, became jealous of **Moosa** and he instigated the entire **Bin Laavi** clan against him” {part 4, chapter 3}.

The Jewish Encyclopaedia says:

Qaroon is mentioned with regard to unusual wealth. He had got hold of one of the treasures which Yusuf had buried in Egypt. The treasure was so big that 300 mules were required only for carrying the keys to his treasure trove {vol.7, page 556}.

The revelation communicated by all the messengers was meant to abolish capitalism, and that is why the Quran has referred to **Qaroon** as an example to illustrate this issue. The mentality of a capitalist is that he thinks that whatever he earns is due to his artisanship and cleverness. Therefore, it is his sole prerogative to own it and nobody else has any share in it or has a right. It is up to me to collect as much as I can and spend it as I wish.

Qaroon, whom Quran has quoted that he used to say this:

28:78	he said that all this has been acquired due to his own expertise	قَالَ إِنَّمَا أُوتِيتُهُ عَلَىٰ عِلْمٍ عِنْدِي
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It needs to be looked at more closely that what a man calls his expertise and intellect to earn and accumulate this wealth, how much of this he gets it through the chance of his birth and how much of it really belongs to his own efforts. For example our intellect and physical abilities including gender, colour, etc are God given which we are endowed at the time of our birth. The lottery of birth puts us in a rich family or a poor family and again this is not a product of our efforts. The capitalist system in which we are born is not our creation and those of us born in a wealthy family get a head start as compared to those who are born in a poor family. So the advantage we get is not through our efforts. In the outer world the land and other means of production have all been given by nature and the first man got them free and then he gradually started drawing lines on the face of the earth to call it mine – something which he got it free. In short only man's labour is his own and the rest is given by nature. Hence according to the Quran, he has a right only to the returns of his labour, and everything else belongs to Allah. About his own share, Allah says that it should be available to mankind in general. Thus **Qaroon's** mentality or the mentality of people like him is a violation of these injunctions which puts us in direct confrontation with Allah as per the Quran (2:22). Indeed none of us owns anything except our inner self and the proof lies in our death when we do not take anything with us including our physical self.

Therefore the Quran says about **Qaroon's** mentality:

28:78	Did he not know that God had earlier destroyed nations which were more powerful and numerous than this?	أَوَلَمْ يَعْلَم أَنَّ اللَّهَ قَدْ أَهْلَكَ مِنْ قَبْلِهِ مِنَ الْقُرُونِ مَنْ هُوَ أَشَدُّ مِنْهُ قُوَّةً وَأَكْثَرَ جَمْعًا
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In the capitalist system, destruction is inherently inbuilt within the system and it is not sustainable on a long term basis.

“الْقَبِيحُ” (*al-qabeeh*): the thing which the eye is abhorrent to look at and the deed which a man hates.
 “مَقْبُوحٌ” (*maqbooh*): the man who is thought to be mean and demeaning and who is ousted, or the thing which has been made execrable. It also means that thing which is kept away from good.

Ibn Faris says “قَبَحَهُ” (*qabahu*) means “removed him” and “distanced him”. He said its basic meaning is the opposite of beauty.

“نَاقَةٌ قَبِيحَةُ الشَّحْبِ” (*naqaatun qabeehatush shakhb*): a she-camel, the openings of whose teats are very wide.

“قَبَحَ الْبَيْضَةَ” (*qabahal-baizah*): he broke the egg. This word is used to mean breaking up other things too

“الْقُبْحُ” (*al-qubh*): the opposite of beauty, i.e. ugly.

The Quran says about the criminals:

28:42	They will be deprived of all the happiness of life and face ignominy. (their capabilities will be destroyed)	هُمْ مِنَ الْمَقْبُوحِينَ
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“الْقَبْرُ” (*al-qabr*): the place where a corpse is buried.

“الْمَقْبَرَةُ” (*al-maqbarah*): graveyard.

“قَبَرَهُ” (*qabarah*), “يَقْبِرُهُ” (*yaqbiruhu*), “يَقْبُرُهُ” (*yaqburuh*): he buried him {T, R}.

Surah *Al-Abus* says:

81:21	Then Allah gives him death and makes him to be placed in the grave (causes him to be buried)	ثُمَّ أَمَّا تُو فَاقْبَرُهُ
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Here “قَبَرَهُ” (*qabarah*) has not been used but “اَقْبَرَهُ” (*aqbarah*) which is used when someone buries someone with his own hands.

“مَقْبَرَةٌ” (*maqbarah*) has “مَقَابِرُ” (*maqabir*) as it's plural.

Surah *At-Takasur* says:

102:2	Until you visit these <i>maqabir</i> (i.e. you die)	حَتَّىٰ زُرْتُمُ الْمَقَابِرَ
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The Quran uses the term (*mun fil qubur*) i.e. those within the graves in (35:22) and (22:7). It is a reference to those who have been deprived of the blessing of life or who have proceeded so far in their bias that no amount of advice would do them any good. For details, see heading (M-W-T) and (H-Y-Y).

It should be kept in mind that when the Quran says “مَنْ بَعَثْنَا مِنْ مَرْقَدِنَا” (*mun ba asana min marqadana*) as in (36:53), it does not mean that the dead will be raised from certain places or graves. If this is the case then what about the dead who are not buried? Burial is simply a form of disposing of the dead. Other nations use other methods e.g. cremation. The Quran's purpose is to relate to the life after physical death. Among the Arabs the dead were buried and that is why the Quran has used the word graves, otherwise life after death needs neither graves nor the body which becomes useless at death. As per the Quran, the life after death is certain, but as to what will be its form, cannot be conceived at the stage of our present living. Even otherwise the importance is of life itself, not of the form it might take.

“الْقَبَسُ” (*al-qabas*): flame which is acquired from a big fire.

“الْمُقْتَبَسُ” (*al-muqtabas*): a piece of the fire {T, M}

“اِقْتَبَسَ” (*iqtabas*): he took some fire from the bigger fire {T, M}.

“اِقْتَبَسَ الْعِلْمَ” (*iqtabasal-ilm*): to benefit from someone in knowledge {T, M}.

Surah *Taha* says:

20:10	I may bring a flame from a fire to you	آتَيْنَكُم مِّنْهَا بِقَبَسٍ
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Surah *Al-Hadeed* says:

57:13	May we take some light from your light	نَقْتَبِسُ مِنْ نُّورِ كُمْ
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“قَبَضَ عَلَيْهِ يَدَهُ” (*qabaza alaihi bi yadihi*): he caught him with his full claw, or grasped him.

“قَبَضَ يَدَهُ عَنْهُ” (*qabaza yadahu unhu*): he shrank from holding him.

“قَبَضَ” (*qabaz*): to pull or shrink {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “to take something” and “for something to shrink” or “to condense”.

It is the opposite of “بَسَطَ” (*basat*) as in (2:245), which means to expand and make bigger.

Surah *Al-Furqaan* says:

25:46	And then we gradually pull him towards us	ثُمَّ قَبَضْنَاهُ إِلَيْنَا قَبْضًا يَسِيرًا
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“قَبْضَةً” (*qabzah*): possession.

Surah *Az-Zumr* says:

39:67	During the period of Qiyamah (The Quranic System), all avenues of sustenance will be in the grip of the same God in whose possession this universe is	وَالْأَرْضُ جَمِيعًا قَبْضَتُهُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ وَالسَّمَاوَاتُ مَطْوِيَّاتٌ بِيَمِينِهِ
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This above verse means that at that particular time, sustenance will also be in the possession of Allah's system. It will not be that the universe will run according to the laws of Allah and on the earth there will be a man-made laws regarding human sustenance. To have such a concept is called *shirk*.

“قَبْضَةً” (*qabzah*): to adopt.

Surah *Taha* says about the *Samri* sorcerer, who said:

20:94	I have adopted a little from the system of the messenger (<i>Moosa</i>) and then even left that.	فَقَبَضْتُ قَبْضَةً مِّنْ أَثَرِ الرَّسُولِ فَنَبَذْتُهَا
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“مَقْبُوضَةً” (*maqboozah*): that which is seized, or which has been possessed in the hand (2:283).

About birds, surah *Al-Mulk* says:

67:19	they spread their wings and gathered them in (general meaning)	صَلَّتْ وَ يَمِضُنَّ
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But *Taj* says that “قَبْضَ الطَّائِرِ” (*qabazat taa-ir*) means the bird made haste in flying.

“فَرَسٌ قَبِضُ الشَّدِّ” (*farsun qabeezush shad*): a horse which raises its feet quickly {T}. *Ibn Faris* too says it has this meaning.

“قَبْلُ” (*qabl*) is the opposite of later. It also means without.

The Quran says:

30:4	Before and after is the work of Allah	لِلَّهِ الْأَمْرُ مِنْ قَبْلُ وَمِنْ بَعْدُ
18:109	without my Sustainer saying being true or completed {F}	قَبْلَ أَنْ تَنْعَدَ كَلِمَتُ رَبِّي

Here it can also mean before.

“الْقَبْلُ الْقَبْلُ” (*al-qublu al-qubul*) is the opposite of “الدُّبُرُ وَالدُّبُرُ” (*ad-duburu ad-duburu*). It is the opposite of behind i.e. in front.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:26	If his shirt has been torn in front.	وَإِنْ كَانَ فَمِصُّهُ قُدَّ مِنْ قُبُلٍ
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“الْقَبْلُ” (*al-qubl*): the foot of a mountain (width-wise).

“الْقَبْلُ مِنَ الزَّمَنِ” (*al-qublu minaz zamn*): the initial part of an era.

“الْقَبْلَةُ” (*al-qublah*): kiss.

“قَوَائِلُ الْأَمْرِ” (*qawabilul amr*): the initial part of an issue, as a foreword.

“الْقَابِلَةُ” (*al-qaabilah*): the coming night, or imminent night, or a woman who gives birth {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for something to be in front of something. But the word which is the opposite of later does not fall under this meaning.

“قِبْلُ” (*qibal*): in front, face to face, towards, direction. It also comes to mean close, close by.

Surah *Al-Hadeed* says:

57:14	towards the outside, or from inside, both ways the punishment can come	وظَاهِرُهُ مِنْ قِبَلِهِ الْعَذَابُ
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Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:177	towards the east	قِبَلَ الْمَشْرِقِ
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But if “قِبْلُ” (*qibl*) is considered to be the plural of “قِبْلَةٌ” (*qiblah*), then it would mean the “قِبْلَةُ” (*qiblah*) of the east and west. See details ahead.

“تَقَبَّلَهُ وَ قَبِلَهُ” (*taqab balahu wa qabilah*): he took it, accepted it {T, M}.

The Quran says:

42:25	He is the one who accepts atonement from his servants (followers)	وَهُوَ الَّذِي يَقْبَلُ التَّوْبَةَ عَنْ عِبَادِهِ
40:3	one who accepts pardon	قَابِلِ التَّوْبِ

“تَقَبَّلَ” (*taqabbal*): to accept something in a way that it becomes deserving of a reward. {T, M}.

5:27	Allah accepts the good deeds of only those who follow His guidance.	إِنَّمَا يَقْبَلُ اللَّهُ مِنَ الْمُتَّقِينَ
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In these verses “to accept” means to take something, like we accept some offerings. It means their deeds get good results according to the Law of Requit, and only those deeds which are in line with the Revelation can produce good results (as noted in the Quran).

About **Maryam**, the Quran relates:

3:36	God accepted it well	فَتَقَبَّلَهَا رَبُّهَا بِقَبُولٍ حَسَنٍ
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“قبيل” (*qabeelun*) and “قبول” (*qubul*): openly, face to face. It also means responsible, patron and representative {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

6:112	We would have brought together all the things in front of them	وَحَشَرْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ قُبُلًا
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“القيل” (*al-qibalu*): strength and force {*T, M*}.

2:37	they wouldn't have the strength to fight our armies: they will not be able to face them	فَلَنَأْتِيَنَّهُمُ الْجُنُودُ لَا قِيْلَ لَهُمْ بِهَا
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“القيل” (*al-qabeel*): husband. It also means a group of three or more people who belong to the same forefather, or descendants of the same father. Plural is “قبائل” (*qaba-il*) as in (49:13).
 “قبائل الرأس” (*qabaa-ilur raas*): the bones of the skull which join each other.

Zajaaj says that for the descendants of the tribe of **Ismail** “قبيلة” (*qabeelah*) is used and for the tribe of **Ishaq** “سبط” (*sibt*) is used. Plural of it is “أسباط” (*asbaat*).

“القيلة” (*al-qabeelah*): the big rock used to block the mouth of a well.
 “أقبل إليه” (*aqbala ilaih*): he came towards him.
 “أقبل الرجل” (*aqbalar rajul*): he came to his senses after his foolishness.
 “قابله” (*qaabalah*), “مقابله” (*muqaabalah*): he confronted him, came face to face.
 “أقبل عليه” (*aqbala alaih*): attended to him.
 “أقبل على الأمر” (*aqbala alal-amr*): he engaged in that work and did not leave it, or kept it in front of him.
 “تقابلا” (*taqaabala*): they both came face to face {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

15:47	they will be seated on pedestals in front of each other	إِخْوَانًا عَلَى سُرُرٍ مُتَقَابِلِينَ
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“القيلة” (*al-qiblah*): the actual meaning of this word is direction or trend, but generally it means the direction one faces in prayer {*T, M*}. Therefore it means “the faced direction”, or “the direction one kept in front”, or “the direction which is meant or in mind”.

In **Deen**, the “قيلة” (*qiblah*) has a particular significance. Every system, every republic, every government have a centre as a symbol towards which all refer. It creates a unity of thought and homogeneity of deed among them. This is actually the symbol of that system which has to be kept in mind all the time. By keeping it in view (or mind) one expresses his fidelity to that system.

The “قيلة” (*qiblah*) or centre for the system of God could be only one, about which God has said:

3:95	Ka'ba which has been made the symbol of guidance for all mankind	إِنَّ أَوَّلَ بَيْتٍ وُضِعَ لِلنَّاسِ لَلَّذِي بِبَكَّةَ مُبَارَكًا وَهُدًى لِّلْعَالَمِينَ
3:96	he who enters it, finds peace	مَنْ دَخَلَهُ كَانَ آمِنًا

The importance of the “قيلة” (*qiblah*) can be judged from the fact that following the “قيلة” (*qiblah*) has been likened to the following of **Deen**.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:145	Even if you present them with all the verses or reasoning you can, even then they will not follow your qiblah , and neither will you follow theirs and neither will they follow each other's qiblah .	وَلَيْنِ اتَّيْتِ الَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْكِتَابَ بِكُلِّ آيَةٍ مَا تَبِعُوا قِبْلَتَكَ وَمَا أَنْتَ بِتَابِعٍ قِبْلَتَهُمْ وَمَا بَعْضُهُمْ بِتَابِعٍ قِبْلَةَ بَعْضٍ
2:120	The Jews and the Christians will never be happy with you until you follow their way	وَلَنْ تَرْضَى عَنْكَ الْيَهُودُ وَلَا النَّصَارَى حَتَّى تَتَّبِعَ مِلَّتَهُمْ

This shows that **qiblah** is actually the symbol of a way of life or **Deen** and following the **qiblah** means to follow a particular way of life.

The **momineen** have been told that no matter which walk of life they belong to, in whichever part of the world they may be residing, they must fix their direction towards their **qiblah**:

2:150	keep your attention towards it	وَحَيْثُ مَا كُنْتُمْ فَوَلُّوا وُجُوهَكُمْ شَطْرَهُ
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Let your purpose in life be one, and this unity will form the basis of the unity of your nation. The physical form of doing this is to face toward the **qiblah** in prayers. This is the truth which has been stressed and must be followed:

2:177	The path to righteousness is not that you turn your face towards east or west	لَيْسَ الْبِرَّ أَنْ تُوَلُّوا وُجُوهَكُمْ قِبَلَ الْمَشْرِقِ وَالْمَغْرِبِ--
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If **qibaal** is considered as the plural of **qiblah**, then the verse would mean that all the **qiblahs** in the east and the west, be they belong to any nation or religion, are in fact additional and not personal. The things which symbolize a system are important so long as the systems are in place. When they are no longer present, the symbols also lose their significance. These symbols have been called “شعائر الله” (**sha-irillaah**) at another place. See heading (**Sh-Ain-R**). But if the system is no longer present then the respect of the symbols becomes merely customary. This is the point that the Quran wants to make when it says that no matter where you are, keep your attention or direction towards your **Deen**. This will show as to where your fidelity lies, but this also means that turning towards the **qiblah** is not an end in itself – its significance is symbolic.

Then question is that when the system becomes invisible and people who are living individual lives but wish to establish a system, then what **qiblah** should be the centre? Now the question before us is, where should collective life begin? The Quran has pointed to this fact too in the narrative about the **Bani Israel** where it is said that “We sent revelation towards **Moosa**”.

In these conditions:

10:87	Make your homes the centre of salaat and begin the system of salaat from there	وَاجْعَلُوا بُيُوتَكُمْ قِبْلَةً وَأَقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةَ
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This means that this system starts from your homes, and gradually this system will encompass everybody and one **qibla** or centre will be established for all.

Baitul Maqaddas was the centre for the Jews, but the Jews confined Allah's **Deen** to their descendants only. Therefore this centre also turned into their national centre but not the centre for the mankind as a whole. But no religion or nation had the concept of a universal bondage of humanity. Conversely the Quran wanted to bring all mankind to one centre. It could only make **Ka'ba** the centre whose foundation was laid by **Ibrahim** for this very purpose i.e. to unify mankind on one **qibla** (2:127).

This place was declared:

2:125	The sanctuary and centre for all mankind	مَثَابَةَ لِّلنَّاسِ وَ أَمْنًا
22:25	for the residents as well as for those who came from outside	سَوَاءٍ لِّلْعَاقِبِ فِيهِ وَالْبَادِ
3:96	it was made to benefit all mankind	لِّلَّذِي بَنَاهُ مُبَارَكًا وَهُدًى لِّلْعَالَمِينَ

This was the purpose for which **Ka'ba** was made the centre of Allah's **Deen**. As far as the **Muslims** are concerned, for fixing the **qiblah** for the purpose:

2:143	Thus we have made you an international community so that you watch over the deeds of the nations of the world and the messenger becomes the watchman on your deeds	وَكَذَٰلِكَ جَعَلْنٰكُمْ اُمَّةً وَسَطًا لِتَكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ وَيَكُونَ الرَّسُولُ عَلَيْكُمْ شَهِيدًا
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In this verse the purpose of the **muslims'** life and modus operandi has been highlighted. **Ka'ba** has been made the centre so that the **Deen** becomes universal, and the duty of the followers of this **Deen** is to watch over the deeds of other nations of the world to see which nation does what for humanity. For this purpose a collective system is necessary. The centre of this system is the Messenger and after him, his real followers.

Until that system was in place, the purpose of the fixation of the **qiblah** was achieved. When it disappeared, neither did the status of the **muslims** remained what it was nor the status of the **qiblah** as it was before.

To inject soul into the "custom" of prayer and facing the **qiblah** the same system needs to be re-established. In the presence of the Quran, the reinvigorating of that system is very easy. The Quran has been protected and preserved so that the system always remains in this world as a concept and , if for some reason this system disappears, then it can be re-established with the help of the Quran. The world seems to be in need of a world order today which is to establish a universal system. This system can be no other than the Islamic system. The day the world can understand this fact, a true new world order will be established, but what is first required is that the **Muslims** who believe in the Quran establish unity and establish such a system in a piece of land as a model. If there are different **qiblahs** for this **nation** or they remain divided into different sects, then a universal **qiblah** cannot be established.

Q-T-R ق ت ر

“الْقَتَرُ” (*al-qatr*), “الْقَتِيرُ” (*at-taqteer*): the economy or earning which barely meets the needs.
 “قَتَرٌ” (*qatar*), “قَتَرٌ” (*qattar*): to be very frugal in order to meet both ends.
 “لَمْ يُسْرِفُوا وَلَمْ يَقْتُرُوا” (*lum yusrifu walam yaqturu*): neither are they extravagant nor are they miserly (25:67).
 “الْمُقْتِرُ” (*al-muqtir*): hard pressed (2:236). It is the opposite of “الْمُوسِعُ” (*waseeh*) which means a man of abundance.

Surah **Bani Israel** says:

17:100	man (if he does not follow the revelation) is a miser and does not make his wealth available for the benefit of mankind	وَكَانَ الْإِنْسَانُ قَتُورًا
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“الْقَتَرُ” (*al-qatar*): dust cloud, blackness, not clear, hazy, cloudy, dusty colour {**T**}.
 “الْقَتَرَةُ” (*al-qatarah*): dust cloud. Some say that this is the singular for “” (*al-qatarah*).

10:26	they will be engulfed in the blackness of ignominy	تَرْهَقُهُمْ قَتَرَةٌ
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Also see (80:41).

“الْقَتِيرُ” (*al-qateer*): the corners of the circles of armour {**T**}.
 “رَجُلٌ قَاتِرٌ” (*rajulun faatir*): old man {**R**}.

“الْقَتْلُ” (*al-qatl*): to kill someone by hitting someone with a weapon, or stone, or with poison, etc. It is used when one person fights another, or one wants to murder another {T}.

Raghib says it also means to insult another or to make him bend.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to insult or kill someone.

80:17	those who deny the laws of Allah meet destruction	قَتِيلَ الْإِنْسَانُ مَا كَفَرَهُ
9:31	May Allah demean them	قَاتَلَهُمُ اللَّهُ
51:10	destroy or overpower them	قَتِيلَ الْحَرَصُونَ

Raghib says that when Quran says “وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا أَوْلَادَكُمْ حَشِيَّةَ إِمْلَاقٍ” (*wala taqtulu aulaadakum khash yatah imlaaq*) in (17:31) and “وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا أَوْلَادَكُمْ مِنْ إِمْلَاقٍ” (*wala taqtalu aulaadakum min imlaaq*) in (6:152), then it does not mean to actually kill the children but to deprive them of education and a good upbringing. Against this their “إِسْتَحْيَاءٍ” (*istahya*) means to grant them education and insight {R}, i.e. not think that by educating the children expenses will be incurred and add to their poverty.

The expostulation about demeaning or insulting also clarifies the meanings where the killing of the children of the **Bani Israel** is mentioned. See heading (**Dh-B-H**).

“قَتْلٌ” (*qatl*) means to insult, demean or to make someone incredulous so that no one gives it any thought or importance. In other words “make him ineffective”.

“أُقْتُلُوا فُلَانًا” (*uqtulu fulaana*): made him like he was among the dead, i.e. his presence and absence will become irrelevant.

“قَتَلَ الشَّرْبَ” (*qatalash sharaab*): to add water to a drink and make it less effective or potent {T}.

“قَتَلَ الشَّيْءَ خُبْرًا” (*qatalash shaiya khubra*): he acquired full knowledge about that thing.

“إِنَّهُ لَقَتْلُ شَرٍّ” (*innahu laqatlush sharr*): he knows evil very well.

About **Isa** it is said:

4:157	they are completely oblivious of the fact	وَمَا قَتَلُوهُ يَقِينًا
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In the **Al-bustan** too the meaning of “مَا قَتَلُوهُ يَقِينًا” (*maa qatilu yaqeena*) is said to be the same as “لَمْ يُحِيطُوا بِهِ عِلْمًا” (*kum yuheetu bihi ilma*).

“الْمَقْتَلُ” (*al-muqattalu*): a man who is very experienced and knows the truth or facts about things {T}.

As such, everywhere, where the word “قَتْلٌ” (*qatl*) appears in the Quran, it would not mean to kill somebody. Its meanings will be determined with reference to the context in which it is used. Sometimes it will be “to kill”, sometimes it will mean “to demean” and “to insult”, other times it will mean “to make ineffective” or “to destroy”. Sometimes it will mean to deprive of education, and at other times to acquire full knowledge etc. It will also mean to try the utmost. As such “إِسْتَقْتَلَ فِي الْأَمْرِ” (*istaqtal-fil amr*) means that he strives so hard that he even laid down his life on the line in the matter {T}.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says about the Jews:

2:91	they used to demean and insult their messengers (they were bent upon killing or murdering them)	وَيَقْتُلُونَ النَّبِيِّنَ بِغَيْرِ الْحَقِّ
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About **Isa**, it is said at another place that he was not murdered by the Jews, nor was he crucified (4:157).

At another place in the surah it is said:

2:54	bring them to obey Allah's laws	فَاِذْ قَتَلُوا اَنْفُسَهُمْ
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Raghib says “قَتَلْتُ فُلَانًا” (*qataltu fulana*) means the same as “ذَلَّلْتُهُ” (*zallaltuhu*) that is “made him obedient and faithful”.

Surah *An-Nisa'a* says not to usurp each other's wealth unjustly. After this it is said:

4:29	Do not destroy yourself by doing this.	وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ
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In a society in which people start usurping each other's wealth unjustly, all values get destroyed.

In the Quran the word "قَتَالٌ" (*qitaal*) has generally appeared to mean "battle" as in (2:216), but in (3:153) "كُتِبَ عَلَيْهِمُ الْقَتْلُ" (*kutiba alaihim qatl*) means "those people of the *momineen* for whom battle was made compulsory. This does not mean those who were destined to be killed, firstly because "كُتِبَ عَلَى" (*kutiba alaihim*) means to make something compulsory, and secondly because "قَتْلٌ" (*qatl*) does not only mean to be killed but also to commit murder, as in (2:217), and thirdly if the meaning "they were destined to be killed" is taken then it revolts against all the teachings of the Quran which teaches that man is not helpless and can exercise his own right.

For the punishment of murder see heading (*Q-Sd-Sd*).

Q-Th-A ق ت أ

"قُتَاءٌ" (*qisaa-un*), "قُتَاءٌ" (*qusa-un*): cucumber {*T*}.
The Quran uses "قُتَاءٌ" (*qisaa-un*) in (2:61).

Q-H-M ق ح م

Ibn Faris says it means to implement something strongly.

"الْإِقْتِحَامُ" (*al-iqtihaam*): to enter into a very risky matter.
"قَحَمَ الرَّجُلُ فِي الْأَمْرِ" (*qahamar rajulu fil amr*): he unthinkingly put himself into that thing.
"تَقَحَّمَتْ بِهِ النَّاقَةُ" (*taqah hamat bihin naaqah*): the camel ran away wildly with him.
"قَحَمَهُ الْفَرَسُ" (*qah hamatahul fars*): the horse threw him face down {*T*}.

Raghib says it means the horse entered a dangerous place with the rider {*R*}.

38:59	this is a group which will join you blindly	هَذَا فَوْجٌ مُتَّبِعٌ مَعَكُمْ
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"مَحَالَةٌ قَحُومٌ" (*mahalatun qahoom*): a rotary thing that rotates very fast:
"اِقْتَحَمَ الْمَنْزِلَ" (*iqtahamal-manzil*): he burst into the house: it has an element of intensity {*T*}: that is, to come towards a purpose speedily:

Surah *Al-Balad* says:

90:11	does not make haste on the path that is steep	فَلَا اقْتَحَمَ الْعَقَبَةَ
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Man does not enter it brazenly by braving all the storms in his way. Although if he comes to know the reality, then this is the destination he would come towards ardently.

- 1) “قَدْ” (*qadd*): is used for expressing an event of past as immediate past.
 “قَدْضَرَبَ” (*qad zarab*): he has surely beaten.

2:242	now that we have been separated from our families and our homes why should we not fight in the way of Allah (for the supremacy of Allah's <i>Deen</i>)	وَمَالَنَا أَلَا نَقَاتِلَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَ قَدْ أُخْرِجْنَا مِنْ دِيَارِنَا وَ أَتْنَانَا
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- 2) To stress along with past tense.

23:1	<i>momin</i> are surely successful (or will be successful)	قَدْ أَفْلَحَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ
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- 3) To stress along with present tense

24:64	God surely knows your condition	قَدْ يَعْلَمُ مَا أَنْتُمْ عَلَيْهِ
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- 4) To mean often or many times:

2:144	We have often see you looking towards the sky	قَدْ نَرَى تَقَلُّبَ وَجْهِكَ فِي السَّمَاءِ
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- 5) Sometimes this word is used to mean ‘sometimes’:

“قَدْ يَصْدُقُ الْكُذُوبُ” (*qad tasduqul kuzub*): a liar also sometime tells the truth.

“قَدْ يَفْتَمُ الْعَايِبُ” (*qad yaddamul ghaaib*): he expects that whoever is not here will come.

“قَدْ فَعَلَ” (*qad fa'al*): he has already performed this act, or when somebody wants to know someone's welfare, or whether that person is still living or has died. Then in reply it will be said:

“قَدْ مَاتَ فُلَانٌ” (*qad matya fulan*): that man is dead, or he has died.

- 6) By adding “لَ” (*laam*) in front of “قَدْ” (*qad*) the stress is enhanced i.e. when “لَقَدْ” (*laqad*) is used, it is said with more surety.

Q-D-H

ق د ح

“الْقِدْحُ” (*al-qidh*): the shaft of an arrow which has no adorning feathers etc.

- 1) For a hole or gap to appear in something for some reason.

- 2) To scoop out something with the spoon, etc.

“الْقَدَحُ” (*al-qadah*): a bowl or cup.

“قَدَحٌ” (*qadah*): an empty cup

“كَاسٌ” (*kaas*): a full cup is called.

“قَدَحَ بِالزَّنْدِ” (*qadah biz zand*): he made fire from the flint stones.

“قَدَحَ فِي فُلَانٍ قَدْحاً” (*qadaha fee fulanin qadha*): he cast aspersions on him.

The Quran says:

100:2	the horses which so stamp on stones as to cause sparks to fly	فَالْمُورِلَاتِ قَدْحاً
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“الْقَدُّ” (*al-qadd*): to cut, to cut or split something length wise, to divide a ground, to cut some speech, build or paring off for finesse {*T, Kitab-ul-Ashfaaq*}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:65	that woman tore his shirt	وَقَدَّتْ قَمِيصَهُ
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“الْقِدَّةُ” (*al-qiddah*): piece, sect, a group of people. The plural is “قِدَدٌ” (*qidad*).

The Quran says:

72:11	we were divided into various sects: we had adopted different ways	كُنَّا طَرَائِقَ قِدَدًا
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Hence it means people who have different aims and therefore differ with one another {*T*}.

“قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*): basically means estimate or measure or scale.

“قَدَرْتُ الشَّيْءَ” (*qadartush shaiyi*): I measured that thing: estimated it: assessed its length, breadth, volume etc. estimated what its weight was, how much it was, how proportionate it was etc.

“قَدَرْتُ الشَّيْءَ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*qadrush shaiyi bishaiyi*): he measured one thing against another and estimated if that thing is equal to other: or what is their mutual proportion.

“قَدَرْتُ عَلَيْهِ الثَّوبَ” (*qadartu alihis saub*): He made clothes as per the measurement.

“قَدَرْتُ عَلَيْهِ الشَّيْءَ” (*qadartu alihish-shaiyi*): I have made such alterations to this thing that it fits perfectly.

“تَقْدِيرٌ” (*taqdeer*): to make one thing according to another.

“مُقَدَّارٌ” (*miqdaar*): the model or pattern or measure according to which something is made.

“قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*): the estimate about something as a measure, volume, bulk, length, breadth etc.

“هَذَا قَدْرُ هَذَا” (*haaza qadru haaza*): this thing is exactly according to the other. Both seem built according to the same model.

“جَاءَ عَلَى قَدْرٍ” (*ja'a ala qadrin*): he came exactly as estimated.

“جَاوَزَ قَدْرَهُ” (*jaawaza qadruhu*): he exceeded his own estimates.

“أَقْدَرُ” (*aqdaru*): a horse which walks so that its hind legs follow the footprints of its forelegs.

“قُدَّارٌ” (*qudaar*): a man of medium height.

“الْمُقْتَدِرُ” (*al-muqtadar*): the middle part of anything.

“كَمْ قَدْرُهُ نَخْلِكَ” (*kam qudratu nakhlik*): what is the distance between your date palms {*T, M, L, R*}.

“الْمُقَدِّرُ” (*al-muqidida*): a man who correctly estimates as to how much crop can be expected from the fruit trees or the fields.

“قَدْرٌ” (*qidr*) with its plural “قُدُورٌ” (*qudoor*) means “a big pot”.

“قَدِيرٌ” (*qadeer*): the meat which is cooked with proper spices in a big cooking pot.

“قُدَّارٌ” (*qudaar*): the cook of such food. It also means a butcher {*T, M, L, R*}.

These instances show that “قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*) and “تَقْدِيرٌ” (*taqdeer*) mean estimate or measure, or to make something according to the estimate or measure. It also means to keep the right balance of something, or to be temperate. These basic meanings will help understand the Quran where these words appear.

2) To make something according to a measure one needs expertise, so “قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*) also means to have full ability and right over something.

“قَدَرْتُ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*qadartu alash shaiyi*): I had the ability to make that thing according to my wishes or my measure.

“مَالِي عَلَيْكَ مَقْدَرَةٌ” (*maa li aliaka maqduratun*): I have no right or power over you.

“مَقْدَرَةٌ” (*qaddara*), “مَقْدَرَةٌ” (*maqdarah*), “مَقْدِرَةٌ” (*maqdira*), “قُدْرَةٌ” (*qudrah*): to prepare something and to deliberate upon some matter in order to perform that deed. It also means to decide {*R*}.

3) When you give something without measuring it, then obviously there is an element of generosity, but measuring a thing while giving it has some miserliness or narrowness implied. “قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*) therefore also means narrowness, i.e. to give someone strictly according to a measure {R}. It also means to respect, i.e. to assess correctly the stage at which something is {R}.

Surah *Ar-Raad* says:

13:17	when Allah makes it rain then rivers etc. fill up according to their capacity and begin flowing	أَنْزَلَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً فَسَالَتْ أَوْدِيَةٌ بِقَدَرِهَا
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Here the meaning of “قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*) is capacity or measurement clearly.

Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

15:21	There is nothing that we do not have as a treasure with Us, but we bring it forth according to a measurement or estimate	وَإِنْ مِنْ شَيْءٍ إِلَّا عِنْدَنَا خَزَائِنُهُ وَمَا نُنْزِلُهُ إِلَّا بِقَدَرٍ مَعْلُومٍ
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Surah *Saba* says that the wild men used to make for *Suleman*, among other things, such big pots which were stationed at a place (because of their size):

“قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*) in verse (34:13) means big pot.

The Quran says:

5:34	Before you overpower them	مِنْ قَبْلِ أَنْ تَقْدِرُوا عَلَيْهِمْ
21:87	He though we will not be able to overpower them (will not be able to question him)	فَطَنَ أَنْ لَنْ نَقْدِرَ عَلَيْهِ
17:30	Indeed your Sustainer extends the provision for those who follow the laws which help to increase it	إِنَّ رَبَّكَ يَبْسُطُ الرِّزْقَ لِمَنْ يَشَاءُ وَ يَقْدِرُ

Here “قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*) has come against “بَسَطَ” (*bast*) which means generosity or expanse. So “قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*) means narrowness or to get something only in measure (not generously).

To comprehend the right meaning of “تَقْدِيرٌ” (*taqdeer*) see the heading (*Sh-Y-A*) and consider the three meanings which have been mentioned therein. It has been mentioned therein that the first stage is where according to “أمر الٰهِي” (*amr ilahi*) or God’s wishes, everything is created. Later laws for its (functioning) are formulated. These particularities and laws are the ‘measurements’ of these things. These are called the *taqdeer* of these things. Like the *taqdeer* of fire is to burn and provide heat, the *taqdeer* of water is that it is liquid, flows towards the slope, turns into vapour at a certain temperature and then condensed or turns back to water again, and if further condensed, turns hard as ice.

Surah *Al-Furqaan* says:

25:2	God has created everything then fixed their scales	خَلَقَ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ فَقَدَرَهُ تَقْدِيرًا
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Raghib says there are two forms of a thing’s *taqdeer*, i.e. to create something at once and there will be no lacunae in it till God wants to change something in it or wants to destroy it. Like “سَمَوَاتٌ” (*samawaat*), the other is that potentialities have been created in things and with time they gradually reach their fruition and cannot turn into anything else. Like the seed has the potentiality of becoming a tree, this is its *taqdeer*.

Raghib’s first statement, that whatever was to be created has been created, could be made only in the era during which he lived. In our times the research shows that things here to fore thought to be without change also undergo a process of change. But these changes are very subtle and almost imperceptible. However, *taqdeer* means to develop a thing on a pattern fixed for it till it reaches completion. That is, for its potentialities to become actualities and thus reach the final stage.

“مَقْدُورٌ” (*maqdoor*): a thing which comes to light according to its fixed pattern.

The Quran says that when **Moosa** was being given messenger-hood, he was told that he was not being given the messenger-hood by chance. For this, he was being prepared and watched from the very beginning.

(**Moosa** was told that) so you were born the way you were, and were so brought up, and so you came towards **Madyan**, so you were a shepherd there and you were thus trained, and so you were made to go through many stages and so:

40:20	O Moosa , then you reached this stage and came up to the criterion that was required for this	ثُمَّ جِئْتُ عَلَىٰ قَدَرٍ مِّنْ رَبِّي
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All this was due to the program God had fixed {L}. Here the meaning of “قَدَرٌ” (*qadar*) has become explicit.

Surah **Al-Aala** says:

87:2	God is the One who creates different things in the universe	الَّذِي خَلَقَ فَسَوَّىٰ
87:3	Then He creates the right proportion in them (fixes the scales for them, and leads them to the path, so that they can fulfill their potentialities)	وَالَّذِينَ قَدَرْنَا مِدَادًا

This is the system of Allah that is working in the universe, and as per which everything reaches its fixed **taqdeer**. The human being too possesses some potentialities, but like other things in the universe it has not been mandatory for him to follow a certain path as no path is fixed for him, or he is not forced to reach his **taqdeer**. He has been given the right to choose the path on which his potentialities can reach fruition or he can chose the other way which will cause his abilities to be stifled. This differentiation can be made with the help of the revelation (which is contained in the Quran). So whichever path man chooses or stops at whichever stage in this path, will be as per the law of Requital as explained in the Quran. The initiative is with man, and Allah’s law is effective as and when man has made a decision and takes action, then the effects show up.

The Quran says:

61:5	When they adopted the crooked (wrong) path, God made their hearts crooked {L}	فَلَمَّا زَاغُوا أَزَاغَ اللَّهُ قُلُوبَهُمْ
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Note that **Moosa** was unaware of the stages, and he was being made to pass through them because before being appointed a messenger one does not even know that he will be appointed messenger. Thus revelation is God given, not acquired by some effort or expertise.

At another place it is said:

51:8	He who turns away from the right path is the one who is made to turn away from the path	يُؤْفِكْ عَنْهُ مَنَافِكُ
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This means that Allah’s law is applied to whatever way man adopts. Man has great possibilities and also the choice of his destinies (the laws of Allah) is very vast. The way he himself becomes, so will his **taqdeer**. A verse of the poet **Iqbal** when translated means that if you are at a stage and the results of Allah’s laws are not good, and then create a change in yourself. This will make another one of Allah’s laws apply to you or your **taqdeer** will change.

The foregoing, according to the Quran, is what **taqdeer** means.

As such when it is said “إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَىٰ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ” (*innallaaha ala kulli shaiyin qadeer*) then it will mean that the laws of Allah are ruling everything and taking everything to fruition or its ultimate end (**taqdeer**), and Allah’s law will apply to man according to where he places himself. It is man’s right as to which place he wants to keep himself at, and thus which **taqdeer** he chooses for himself. But no matter at which stage he keeps himself, he cannot avoid the appropriate law of Allah.

Quran's declaration that God has fixed proportions, balances, laws for everything in the universe is a great revelation in the world of knowledge.

Today scientific discoveries are proving at every step that there are laws at work in the universe and nothing is without a grand scheme. The entire universe is working on a rational basis. Rational is a word which means according to a ratio, and ratio is what measurement, balance, scales, etc.

33:39	everything with Allah is according to a proportion	وَكَانَ أَمْرُ اللَّهِ قَدَرًا مَّقْدُورًا
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Here everything is rational, not “blind nature”, nor is man helpless. That which is written beforehand is only the Law, not what we call man's *taqdeer*. A man makes his own *taqdeer* (according to the natural cause and effect). We have seen earlier that the Quran has called the laws of Allah as “قَدْرٌ” (*qadr*). These laws are working in man's world as well as in the external universe. These are the permanent values which are unchanging, and according to which man's deeds produce results. That is why the “night” of revelation has been called “لَيْلَةُ الْقَدْرِ” (*lailatul qadr*) in (97:1-3). Here it means the night or dark times when the light of the revelation was not present, or the night or dark times in which the human world was granted new values. It is these permanent values, through which man is elevated above the level of animals. Whenever anything in the physical life of a man clashes with the permanent values, he is supposed to sacrifice the physical values or interests in favour of the higher values and even one's life. *Deen* is the protector of the permanent values given by the Quran.

Q-D-S

ق د س

“قَدَسَ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*qadasa fil arz*): he went way out {L}.
 “قَدَّسَهُ” (*qaddasah*): he removed all fault.

In the Quran, the *malaika* have said “نُقَدِّسُ لَكَ” (*nuqaddisu lak*) in (2:31).

Zajaaj says that it means “we cleanse ourselves too for yourself and also cleanse all those who obey you” {L}.

But we believe it means what we have mentioned later.

“قُدُّوسٌ” (*quddus*): free of all kinds of faults and blemishes. It is an attribute of God as mentioned in (59:23).
 “الْقُدَّاسُ” (*al-qudaas*): valuable rank: also that stone which is placed to measure the quantities of water so that it can be apportioned {T}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* uses “نُسَبِّحُ” (*nusabbihu*) and “نُقَدِّسُ” (*nuqaddisu*) together in (2:31), therefore also see heading (*S-B-H*), so that the meanings are very clear. Briefly, it would mean to go far out in order to make Allah's program praise worthy. It would also mean to struggle very hard, or to strive utmost.

For the meaning of “رُوحُ الْقُدُسِ” (*Roohul Qudus*) see heading rah, (*R-W-H*).

“الْأَرْضُ الْمُقَدَّسَةُ” (*al-arz ul-muqaddasa*): the land where all the accoutrements of life are available in plenty, or in abundance, i.e. a blessed land (5:21). Also see heading (*B-R-K*). It is also the name of the land located between *Furaat* and *Egypt* {T}, commonly known as *Palestine*.

“أَقْدَامُ” (*al-qadam*): foot (16:94). The plural is “أَقْدَامُ” (*aqdaam*).

“قَدَّمَ” (*qadam*): to move forward, to be the first to move.

“مُقَدَّمَةُ الْجَيْشِ” (*muqaddamatul jaish*), “مُقَدِّمَةُ الْجَيْشِ” (*muqaddimatul jaish*): the front rank of the army.

“مُقَدَّمَةٌ” (*muqaddamah*): the initial part of anything.

“قَدَّمَ” (*qaddama*): to present {T}.

Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

15:5	No nation can advance their term, and neither can delay it.	مَا تَسْبِقُ مِنْ أُمَّةٍ أَجَلَهَا وَمَا يَسْتَأْخِرُونَ
7:34	So when comes their term, they cannot seek to delay that by an hour and cannot advance either	فَإِذَا جَاءَ أَجَلُهُمْ لَا يَسْتَأْخِرُونَ سَاعَةً وَلَا يَسْتَقْدِمُونَ

Hence “قَدَّمَ” (*qadam*) means to compete and to keep on going ahead, therefore “مُسْتَقْدِمِينَ” (*mustakhireen*) has appeared against “مُسْتَأْخِرِينَ” (*mustaqdimeen*) in (15:24).

At several places, the Quran has used “مَا قَدَّمَ مَتَّ أَيْدِيهِمْ” (*ma qaddamat aidihim*) as in (2:95). It means “all that which their hands have sent ahead”. This is referring to human deeds. Since a man’s death takes place after he has done what ever deeds he does, therefore the consequences of his deeds go ahead of him. Whatever deed is done, is part of the past and beyond human grasp, and since the results of deeds are also formulated along with the deeds, they have been called “that which have been sent ahead due to which we are facing this punishment” as “مَنْ قَدَّمَ لَنَا بَدَأَ” (*mun qaddama lana haaza*) in (38:61).

As such *jannat* and *dozakh* i.e. heaven and hell are built by man’s deeds himself, but they become evident at a certain time only in this world as well as in the hereafter.

Surah *Yunus* says:

10:2	tell (predict for) those with belief that they will have <i>qadama sidq</i> with their Sustainer	وَبَشِّرِ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَنَّ لَهُمْ قَدَمٌ صِدْقٍ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِمْ
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Here “قَدَّمَ” (*qadam*) means honour, loftiness, high rank and preference, in other words, such development of the abilities with which life can be well prepared to proceed to the next stages. It also means stability and solidness.

Terms like “قَدِيمٌ” (*qadeem*) and “حَادِثٌ” (*haadis*) are not Quranic, although they have been used by the Quran to mean something which is relics of the past.

“الْعُرْجُونُ الْقَدِيمُ” (*al-urjoonil qadeem*): dry branch (36:39).

“إِفْكٌ قَدِيمٌ” (*ifkun qadeem*): the lie or false hood that has sustained over the past or of old (46:11).

“أَقْدَامُونَ” (*aqdamoon*): forefathers, i.e. people of old times (26:76).

The Quran says:

25:23	Do not give preference to your ownself between the authority of Allah’s laws and His Messenger	لَا تُقَدِّمُوا بَيْنَ يَدَيِ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ
49:1	Do not give preference to self over Allah and His messenger (over Allah’s laws) i.e. Do not cross them, rather obey them.	لَا تُقَدِّمُوا بَيْنَ يَدَيِ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ
48:2	The nonsense that they have been talking about you are false accusations.	مَا تَقَدَّمُ مِنْ ذُنُوبِكِ

“ذُنُوبٌ” (*zanbaka*): false accusations used against the messenger e.g. sorcerer, obsessed, poet, liar, fabricator etc.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:27	those whom you yourself thought to be my partners (those who posed themselves as my partners)	أَيْنَ شُرَكَائِيَ الَّذِينَ كُنْتُمْ تُشَاقِقُونَ فِيهِمْ
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Here “شُرَكَائِي” (*shuraka'i*) does not mean “my partners”.

2:22	Those that you considered to be my partners on your own	شُرَكَاءُ كُمُ الَّذِينَ كُنْتُمْ تَزْعُمُونَ
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As such “زَنْبِكَ” (*zanbika*) would not mean your nonsensical talk, or improper talk (48:2). It means the improper talk with which they blamed you or accused you. See heading (*Dh-N-B*).

Q-D-W ق د و

“الْقِدْوُ” (*al-qidu*): the trunk of a tree from which branches sprout.

“الْقَدْوَةُ” (*al-qadwah*): to progress.

“تَقَدَّتْ بِه دَابَّتُهُ” (*taqaddat bihi dabbah*): the animal took its rider on the straight path {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says this basically means to be like something and to receive guidance from it.

“الْقَدْوَةُ” (*al-qidwah*): he who is followed {*T*}.

“اِقْتَدَى” (*iqtanda*): to follow.

The Quran after mentioning all past messengers tells the Messenger *Muhammed*:

6:91	These are the people whom Allah had given His guidance, so follow the guidance given to them	أُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ هَدَى اللَّهُ فَبِهِدْهُمْ اِقْتَدِهْ
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In other words the messenger is instructed to follow the guidance which was given to messengers before him and now is preserved in the Quran. As such the Quran is the same path that all past messengers have been following. Following the Quran is following the way all messengers have followed. That *Deen* which was given to them is no more present in its original form, but the very same principles which have also been called permanent values, have been given in the shape of the Quran {*T*}. Therefore, anyone who follows the Quran follows the path of the messengers from the past. This is the essence of “فَبِهِدْ بُمُ اِقْتَدِهْ” (*fabihuda humuqtadih*) in (6:91).

“اِقْتَدِهْ” (*iqtanda*) is of the guidance which the messengers have been receiving from God. Any other “اِقْتَدِهْ” (*iqtanda*) or following is the following of cults which the Quran has opposed at several places, as in (43:23).

Q-Dh-F ق ذ ف

Raghib says it means to throw afar {*R*}.

This word also means to speak out something, to throw, or to put something. Metaphorically it also means to allege or accuse {*T*}.

“قَذَفَ” (*qazf*): to throw stones or shoot an arrow etc. {*T*}. It also means to describe someone's faults or to criticize someone {*R*}.

“قَذَفَ الْمُحْصَنَةَ” (*qazafal-muhsinah*): he accused a chaste woman.

“الْقَذَافُ” (*al-qazzaaf*): a sling etc. with which something is shot afar {*T*}.

Surah *Taha* says about *Moosa*:

20:39	Put him into a coffin and then let the box drift in the river.	أَنِ افْذَرْنِي فِي التَّابُوتِ فَافْذِرْنِي فِي الْيَمِّ
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Surah *Ambia* says:

21:18	we keep striking falsehood with truth from time to time	بَلْ نَقْذِفُ بِالْحَقِّ عَلَى الْبَاطِلِ
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Good and evil, or *haq* and *baatil* keep at loggerheads, and the constructive forces prevail at last.

Surah *Saffaat* says:

37:8	they are kept away from all sides	وَيُغْلَقُونَ مِنْ كُلِّ حَانٍ
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Those previous principles (not principles but orders in the light of those principles) which needed any amendment were amended and were put in the Quran. As such, now following God can be done only by following the Quran, as other books have been corrupted by human thoughts and interference over a period of time. Also see heading (*N-S-Kh*).

Q-R-A ق ر أ

“قَرَأَ” (*qara*) basically means to gather {*F*}.

“أَقْرَأَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*aqraatin naqah*): the sperm of the camel embedded in the female camel’s womb and gathered there or stayed there.

“قَرَأَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*qara’atin naaqah*): the she-camel became pregnant.

“قَرَأَ” (*qar’un*): for blood to clot in the womb.

“أَقْرَأَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ” (*aqra’atil mir’ah*): when a woman has menstruation {*T*}. The plural of “قَرَأَ” (*qar’a*) is “قُرُوءٌ” (*quru’un*) as in (2:228). This word is also used when a woman is free of menstruation {*Lughat-ul-Lagha*}.

Zajaaj says “قُرْآنٌ” (*qur’an*) also means to gather, or to bring thing closer together to meet

Ibnul Aseer says the Book of Allah is called “قُرْآنٌ” (Quran) because it has gathered all the explanations, judgements about lawful and unlawful, promises, signs, values, models, and verses all together in a book form {*T*}.

Raghib says it is called Quran because it contains the summary of revealed books inside it, or rather contains the root of all knowledge {*R, Al-Qartyain*}.

The Quran says:

75:17	to collect it and keep it safe (like the sperm is kept safe inside the womb) is Our responsibility	إِنَّ عَلَيْنَا جَمْعَهُ وَقُرْآنَهُ
75:18	Therefore when we gather it (complete it and establish or embed it in your heart) so you follow it.	فَإِذَا قُرْآنُهُ فَاتَّبِعْ قُرْآنَهُ
75:19	So to reveal it before the people openly is also Our responsibility.	ثُمَّ إِنَّ عَلَيْنَا بَيَانَهُ

This shows that the Quran had been completed and had appeared before the people in its completed form during the time of the Messenger. It is therefore not right to believe that the Messenger had left it in a scattered form and it was collected later. Aside from other evidences, the Quran itself is a witness to the fact that it was available in collected and book form.

“أَلْقِرَاءَةٌ” (*al-qiraah*): to join words and letters together.

Ibn Abbas says “فَاتَّبِعْ قُرْآنَهُ” (*futtabih Quranahu*) means to follow the Quran and act according to it.

Some think that “قَرَأَ” (*qara*) is a Hebrew word meaning to announce.

“أَقْرَأْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ” (*iqra bismi rabbika*): announce the sustenance related attribute of your Sustainer (96:1).

This is the same thing that is in surah *Al-Mudassar*:

74:2	Stand up and announce the sustenance related attribute of your	ثُمَّ فَانذِرْ
74:3	Sustainer	وَرَبِّكَ فَكَبِّرْ

According to this, “*Quran*” would mean a public announcement.

The Quran is a Book whose every word is a fact and it brooks certainty and removes every sort of uncertainty (2:2). Whatever Allah had revealed to the Messenger is safe in the Quran (6:19).

- The **momineen** have been asked to follow the Quran and no other dictum (7:3).
- The Messenger of Allah too had been required to follow the Quran (10:109).
- The Holy Messenger used to take decisions according to the Quran (10:109).
- He who does not decide according to the Quranic injunction is not a **momīn** but a denier (5:44).
- Allah's teachings have been included in the Quran and no man can make any amendments (6:116).
- It is the synopsis of all the past teachings (5:48).
- There is no contradictory thing in it (4:82).
- All differences can be resolved with its help (42:10).
- Whatever is said therein has been expostulated by God Himself (75:19).
- It has been called “” (*tibyana likulli shaiyin*) in (16:89). This has been done by repeating verses (17:41), (6:106).
- The Messenger of Allah used to resolve all differences through the Quran (16:64).
- The Messenger used to advise the people with its help (50:45).
- It itself is Light (5:15).
- It illuminates things and has been given to enable man to complete his life's journey in its light (6:123).
- It contains the order to deliberate on it so much (47:24).
- It is made easy and is easy to seek guidance from it (54:16).
- A man must first cleanse his mind of pre-conceived ideas and then seek its guidance (56:79).
- To mix the verses of the Quran with non-Quranic beliefs, thoughts and concepts is **shirk** (42:21) i.e. to do this means the success can never be achieved as declared in the Quran.
- When man is used to personality cults then its advice is very unpleasant for him (40:12, 39:45, 17:46).
- When anyone asks them to look only towards the Quran (besides all other books), they accost him (22:72) and they tell people not to listen to such a person and make a lot of noise so that even others cannot hear him (41:26).
- Not only do they stay away from the Quran themselves but also prevent others from it (2:26).
- There is nothing like the Quran (6:94).
- Opponents wanted to make amendments in it, but the Messenger could not do so (10:15).
- The honour enjoyed by the **momineen** of early era was due to their adherence to the Quran, but when those who came later gave up this adherence, they lost their glory and became a non-entity (43:43). This is the complaint that the Messenger will make to God (25:30).
- **Deen** is only that which is contained in the Quran. By giving up the adherence to the Quran, one gives up the **Deen** itself.

Today we can again adhere to the Quran if we can only understand that the **Deen** and the Quran are one. **Deen** is within the Quran and that which the Quran does not contain is not **Deen** i.e. **Islam = the Quran**. The responsibility for the safety of the Quran has been taken by God Himself (15:9).

“قَرِيبٌ” (*qareeb*) as against “بَعِيدٌ” (*ba'eed*) means to be close (21:109).
 “الْقُرْبُ” (*al-qurb*): to be closer to someone (with reference to distance).
 “الْقُرْبَةُ” (*al-qurbah*): to be close to somebody with reference to rank.
 “الْقُرْبَى” (*al-qurba*) and “الْقَرَبَةُ” (*al-qaraabahu*): to be close to someone with reference to relation, that is, to be a relative.
 “ذِي الْقُرْبَى” (*zil qurbah*): those who are related (2:83).

Surah *Shura* says:

42:23	tell them that I demand no compensation for being a messenger excepting that you love my relatives (General meaning)	قُلْ لَا أَسْأَلُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ أَجْرًا إِلَّا الْمَوَدَّةَ فِي الْقُرْبَى
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This translation is not only against the dictionary but also against the Quranic teachings.

“الْقُرْبَى” (*al-qurb*): as mentioned earlier it means relativity but not relatives.

Lissan-ul-Arab says this verse means “O, Messenger, tell them that I demand no remuneration for my Messenger hood, but at least fulfil the obligations that are due you as my relative” {T}.

17:26	give your relatives their right	أَبِ ذَا الْقُرْبَىٰ حَقَّهُ
2:177	he gave money to his relatives	آتَى الْمَالَ عَلَىٰ حُبِّهِ ذَوِي الْقُرْبَىٰ

Hence verse (42:23) would mean “your own relatives” i.e. “قُرْبَاكُمْ” (*qurbaakum*). That is, if you absolve yourself of your obligations towards your relatives, that is, my remuneration.

This is the same thing which has been described in surah *Saba*:

34:47	tell them the remuneration I want is for your own good	قُلْ مَا سَأَلْتُكُمْ مِنْ أَجْرٍ فَهُوَ لَكُمْ
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Whatever the meaning, it is a fact that the Messenger of Allah did not ask anyone for remuneration nor did any messenger announce that he wanted any remuneration for messenger hood (26:109, 26:14, 35:26).

“الْتَقَرُّبُ” (*at-taqarrubu*): to want to be close to someone and strive for this purpose {T}.

“الْمُقَارَبَةُ” (*al-muqarabah*): to come close to one another.

“الْقُرْبَانُ” (*al-qurbaan*): the thing (offering) with which God’s proximity is desired {T}.

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* mentions two of Adam’s sons, i.e. two men about whom it is said:

5:27	When they presented some sacrifice and the sacrifice of one of them was accepted	إِذْ قَرَّبْنَا قُورَيْنَاهُمَا فَتَقَبَّلَ مِنْ أَحَدِهِمَا
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The Quran gives no details about the sacrifice as to what it was and how it was presented. It could well be something presented as an offering or some good deed which had been done to get closer to God.

The Quran does not mention the word sacrifice for the animals slaughtered at the time of Hajj. The closeness to Allah is not with reference to distance or place. The more a man starts to reflect Allah’s qualities in him, the more he becomes closer to Allah, and the way to reflect Allah’s qualities is to follow Allah’s guidance.

Surah *Al-Alaq* says:

96:19	do not agree with a man who finds ways to avoid the laws of Allah, instead obey these laws of Allah and thus come closer to Allah	لَا تُطِيعُهُ وَاسْجُدْ وَاقْتَرِبْ
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In other words, one may achieve qualities of Allah through reflection upon and actions according to the law of Allah. This is what is meant by the awakening of man and the stability of his personality.

Aulia-e-Allah (the friends of Allah) do not belong to a separate group rather every *momin* is an *aulia-e-Allah*. The laws of Allah can be followed by being part of a society and under a system. It cannot be down as an individual hermit nor in monasticism and neither can Allah's proximity be attained through any other deity's recommendation. See verse (46:28). Such a Deity is only one and it is only Allah.

“قُرْبَةً” (*qurbah*): the way to attain closeness. Plural is “قُرْبَاتٌ” (*qurbaat*) as in (9:99).
 “عَرَضاً قَرِيباً” (*aradan qareeba*): immediate benefit, or quick return (9:42).

In the old ages, people slaughtered their animals and offered them as a sacrifice to please their gods. The Jews used to incinerate these slaughtered animals. Thus sacrifice by fire is often mentioned in the Torah.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:183	A sacrifice which the fire consumes	يُضْرَبَانِ تَأْكُلُهُ النَّارُ
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This verse is a reference to this sort of sacrifice. They believed that if the sacrifice is accepted then the fire consumes the offering. About man's effort to be close to Allah, see heading (*D-Ain-W*).

Q-R-H ق ر ح

“الْقَرْحُ” (*al-qarh*) and “الْقُرْحُ” (*al-qurh*): the wound from a weapon.
 Some say that “الْقَرْحُ” (*alfarh*) means a sword wound.
 “الْقُرْحُ” (*al-qurh*): burning and other sensations due to the wound.
 “بِهِ قَرْحٌ مِنْ قَرْحٍ” (*bihi qurhun min qurh*): he is aching due to his wound {*T, F*}.

Raghib while supporting this meaning says that a wound caused by external sources is “قَرْحٌ” (*qarh*) and that wound which is internal is “قُرْحٌ” (*qurh*).

The Quran has used this word to mean war losses in (3:139), or the trouble suffered due to this kind of loss. Basically both meanings are the same.

Q-R-D ق ر د

“الْقَرْدُ” (*al-qarad*): tangled wool or useless wool {*T*}. It means wool which cannot be woven and is hence thrown away as useless. Later this word started to mean ignominy and humiliation .
 “اَقْرَدَ الرَّجُلُ” (*aqradar rajul*): that man became immobile due to deprivation and destitution, or was insulted and pretended to be dead {*T*}.
 “الْقِرْدُ” (*al-qird*): monkey. The plural is “الْقِرَدَةُ” (*al-qiradah*).
 “الْقِرَادُ” (*al-qiraadh*): lice or bugs which infest camel's hair {*T*}.

The Quran says that the Jews who had violated the orders of Sabbath had been turned into “قِرَدَةٌ خَاسِيَةٌ” (*qiradah khaasi'un*) (2:65). See heading (*Th-B-T*). The meaning of “خَاسِيَةٌ” (*khaasi'un*) is insulted, demeaned, or useless. See heading (*Kh-S-A*).

Surah *An-Nisa* says that they were insulted (4:47), i.e. they were deprived of the pleasantness in life

Verse (7:163-167) explains this by saying that Allah ordered such people to overbear them as would give them different kinds of punishments or perpetrate travails. This shows that this was the same sort of punishment which at another place has been called “زِلَّةٌ” (*zillah*) and “مَسْكَنَةٌ” (*maskanah*) as in (2:61).

In surah *Al-Ma'ida* the hypocrites have also been called “قِرَدَةٌ” (*qiradah*) and this has been explained by saying “عَبَدَ الطَّاغُوتَ” (*abadat ta'ghoot*) in (5:60). It means those who obey evil or falsehood, or those who

do not follow the permanent values.. This very thing is called “لعنت” (*laanat*) and “غضب” (*ghazab*) i.e. not getting the true benefits of life.

These explanations show that “كُونُوا قِرَدَةً خَاسِئِينَ” (*kunu qiradatan khasiyeen*) in (2:65) does not mean that they were really turned into monkeys. It means that that they were truly insulted and lived miserable lives. This was because of instead of following the guidance through the revelation they used to differ on this with each other (16:124). This is the condition of every nation which starts violating the permanent values. They lose character. For example, the loss of character was evident when they did not follow the Sabbath.

Q-R-R ق ر ر

“الْقَرَارُ” (*al-qiraar*): for something to stop, stay put in one place or the place where a thing stops.
 “الْقَرَارَةُ” (*al-qaraarah*): low land where water stops or collects. “قَرَارٌ” (*qaraar*): is also said to mean this.
 “قَرِيًّا لِمَكَانٍ” (*qarra bilmakaan*): to reside somewhere, to stop and stay there.
 “إِسْتِقْرَارٌ” (*istiqaar*): to stop, to be unmoved.
 “أَقَرَّ” (*aqarra*): to make something stop at a place, to make it stay. It also means to accept and agree.
 “مُسْتَقَرُّ الْحَمْلِ” (*mustaqarrul hamal*): the last part of the womb where pregnancy takes place {*T, F*}.

2:84	then you accepted or confessed	ثُمَّ أَقْرَرْتُمْ
2:36	for you the earth has been made a place to rest upon	وَلَكُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ مُسْتَقَرٌّ

The addition of “إِلَىٰ حَيْنٍ” (*ila-heen*) here has shown that this stay on earth is temporary or for a fixed period. But this does not mean that Adam was somewhere else before this and then he was sent to the earth. This whole story is about this earth,. See the word *Adam* under the heading (*A-D-M*). See heading (*W-D-Ain*) for meanings of “مُسْتَقَرٌّ” (*mustaqarrun*) and “مُسْتَوْدَعٌ” (*mastudah*) as used in (6:99).

6:67	every news has a point at which it is either confirmed or denied	لِكُلِّ نَبَأٍ مُسْتَقَرٌّ
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It means that every deed has a result, and every event goes to a certain point where it stops and its results are made evident. This is its “مستقر” (*mustaqar*).

36:38	The sun is (beside revolving) also taking its system towards its <i>mustaqir</i> speedily	الشَّمْسُ تَجْرِي لِمُسْتَقَرٍّ لَهَا
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“الْقَرُّ” (*al-qarr*): a thing which is a cross between the palanquin of a camel and the saddle of horses which is used by men for riding. It also means a howdah which is used by women for sitting on camels {*T, F*}.
 “أَقْرَأَ اللَّهُ عَيْنَهُ” (*aqral-laahu eenahu*): may Allah grant him so much wealth that he would not need to look at people’s wealth greedily or enviously {*T, F*}. The other meaning of this verse is “may Allah keep him happy”.
 “قُرَّةُ الْعَيْنِ” (*qurratul ain*): that which provides solace to the eyes (and contentment to the heart).

The Quran has used “قُرَّةُ آعَيْنٍ” (*qurratah ain*) in (25:74) and “وَقَرَّىٰ عَيْنًا” (*qarri aina*) in (19:26).

“الْقَرُّ” (*al-qarr*): coldness.
 “الْقَرُّ” (*al-qarru*): the cold of winter.
 “بَرْدٌ بَرٌّ” (*bard*): any cold weather in summer or winter {*T*}.
 “قَرَّ عَلَيْهِ الْمَاءُ” (*qarra ilahil ma’a*): put water over him or on him.
 “الْقَارُورَةُ” (*al-qaarurah*): any container, especially of glass, in which wine is stored. The plural is “قَوَارِيرُ” (*qawareer*) as in (76:15-16). Later glass itself came to be called “قَوَارِيرُ” (*qawaryar*). By extension, women were also called so.

The word “قَرَش” (*qarsh*) has a lot of meanings in the dictionary.

Faraa says that this word was the fore runner of the word “قُرَيْشٌ” (*quresh*) which means to collect things from here and there. Since the tribe of *Quresh* were gatherers, they came to be called so.

“تَقَرَّشَ الْقَوْمُ” (*taqarrashal-qoum*): the people gathered. Some think that the *Quresh* were so called because they used to buy trading goods quickly because “تَقَرَّشَ” (*taqarrash*) also means to purchase trading goods first.

Some say that one day *Nazar Bin Anana* (the forefather of the *Quresh* tribe) wrapped himself in cloth and thus the tribe came to be called *Quresh*. Some say that one day the people of his tribe said to him “كَأَنَّهُ جَمَلٌ قُرَيْشٌ” (*ka annahu jamalun quresh*), which means that he looks like a strong camel. And thus he was called *Quresh*. Some say that “قُصِّي” (*qussi*) was called “قَرَشِي” (*qarshi*) and he gave this name to the *Quresh* tribe. Some say that this word means the river monster *qirsh* (whale) which all sea animals were afraid of. Some say this nomenclature stuck because of *Quresh Bin Mukhallad Bin Fahr* who was the leader of their caravan and people used to say that “the *Quresh* caravan has arrived”. Some say that they acquired this name because trading was their only subsistence as they were landless and couldn't do farming.

“فُلَانٌ يَتَقَرَّشُ الْمَالَ” (*fulanun yataqarrashul maal*): that man collects wealth {T}.

Ibrahim made his son *Ismail* settle in *Hijaz* in order to look after the *Ka'ba*. He had twelve sons and *Qidaar* was famous among them.

His descendants divided into a vast number of families. *Quresh* was one of the families and was considered to be considerably honoured and powerful, and respected. Among them *Fahad* (approx. 325 A.D.) and *Qussi Bin Kilaab* (425 A.D.) are very famous. The messenger *Muhammed* was born in this tribe.

By virtue of being the caretakers of the *Ka'ba*, the *Quresh* were respected far and wide. Trade was their profession. They had pacts with several tribes which ensured safety for their caravans. This has been pointed out by the Quran when it says:

106:1	due to the pacts which the <i>Quresh</i> had with others their caravans travel safely during winter and summer	لَا يَلْفُ قُرَيْشٌ اِثْلَهُمْ رَحْلَةَ الشَّتَاءِ وَالصَّيْفِ
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After this the Quran says. This is due to their being the caretakers of the *Ka'ba*. Therefore they should obey the Sustainer of the *Ka'ba*:

106:3	Sustainer of <i>Ka'ba</i> gave them food when they were hungry and provided them peace and security when they were in fear	فَلْيَعْبُدُوا رَبَّ هَذَا الْبَيْتِ الَّذِي أَطْعَمَهُمْ مِنْ جُوعٍ وَآمَنَهُمْ مِنْ خَوْفٍ
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This is fine reasoning. People enjoy benefits in the name of God but worship others. This is not a fair thing. If they benefit in the name of God then they should also obey His laws. And if others are to be obeyed then they should stop linking themselves to God!

“الْقَرْضُ” (*al-qarz*): to cut, delink.

“قَرَضَ الْمَكَانَ” (*qarazal-makaan*): he avoided some place {T}.

“قَرَضَ فِي سَيْرِهِ” (*qaraza fi sairih*): he bent right or left while walking {T} (18:17).

“قَرَضَ” (*qarz*): something which is lent or some deed performed in the hope of getting a return {T}.

“أَقْرَضَ” (*aqraz*): give something or perform some deed in the hope of getting some return.

“قَرَضٌ حَسَنٌ” (*qarzun hasan*): to deal amiably (metaphorical meaning).

The Quran has used this metaphor as in (2:245). This verse means “In the initial stages when Allah’s system is being established then anything which is required should be provided collectively and every effort, every type of bodily or material sacrifice that is needed should be made available happily”

All this mentioned above would be “قَرَضٌ حَسَنٌ” (*qarzun hasan*). But if other meanings of “قَرَضٌ” (*qarz*) too are included with this meaning then the meaning would be more clear.

“الْقَرْضُ” (*al-qarz*): to chew {T}.

“الْقَرِيزُ” (*al-qareez*): a ball of fodder that a camel regurgitates and then chews on, and when it is digestible, returns it to the stomach for making it part of his body {T}.

In the system of Allah, whatever the individual gives to the society is a form of “قَرِيزٌ” (*qareez*). The society spends it at the proper places to obtain the best results. As such, that which the individual had provided comes back to him as an individual of the society.

This is why it is said:

2:245	Is there someone who wants to give <i>qarz hasanah</i> to Allah so that He may return it manifold?	مَنْ ذَا الَّذِي يُقْرِضُ اللَّهَ قَرْضًا حَسَنًا فَيُضَاعِفَهُ أَضْعَافًا كَثِيرَةً
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This increase is with respect to results. Nothing is loaned to Allah directly but to His followers. Therefore a society formulated on the lines of the permanent values, fulfils all the obligations towards the individual that which Allah says are His responsibilities, and recovers the dues which have been imposed by Allah. Everything the individuals in such a society do or give will all be called “قرض حسنه” (*qarz-i-hasanah*).

“الْقَرِطَاسُ” (*al-qirtaas*), “الْقَرِطُسُ” (*al-qirtus*), “الْقَرِطَاسُ” (*al-qartas*): paper or anything which is written upon {T, R}.

Plural is “قَرَاطِيسُ” (*qrates*) as in (6:92).

“الْقَرِطَاسُ” (*al-qirtass*) also means the skin which was hung as a target for shooting arrows {T}.

Muheet says that “الْقَرِطَاسُ” (*al-qirtaas*) means a paper or something that is written upon. Otherwise that something on which nothing is written is called “طِرْسُ” (*tirs*) and “كَاغَذُ” (*kaghaz*). It is also the opposite {T, M}.

The Quran says:

6:7	If we had even revealed a book written on paper.	وَلَوْ أَنزَلْنَاهُ عَلَيْكَ كِتَابًا فِي قَرِطَاسٍ
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“الْقَرْعُ” (*al-qara*): to strike a thing on another {F}.

“قَرَعَ رَأْسَهُ بِالْعَصَا” (*qarahu raasahu bil asa*): Hit the stick on his head.

“قَرَعَ الْبَابَ قَرْعًا” (*qara'al-baaba qar'aa*): knocked on the door.

“الْقَرَأَةُ” (*al-qara'a*): a flinted stone.

“الْمِقْرَاعُ” (*al-miqraa'u*): hammer etc. which is used to break stones with. There is a connotation in this word of harshness, misery, and intensity.

“الْقَرَأَاءُ” (*al-qar'aa'u*): a garden which has been eaten up or grazed by animals.

“رِيَاضٌ قَرْعٌ” (*riaazun qara'un*): a good sword {T}.

The Quran has mentioned “الْقَرْعُ” (*qaari'ah*) which means severe misery which nations face due to pursuit of wrong deeds.

The Quran says:

13:31	Due to their deeds, some misery or other ill continue to meet or befall them	تُصِيبُهُمْ بِمَا صَنَعُوا قَارِعَةٌ
69:4	<i>Thamud</i> and <i>Aad</i> denied the striking calamity	كَذَّبَتْ ثَمُودُ وَعَادٌ بِالْقَارِعَةِ

It refers to the misery which had to come upon them due to natural turn of events. It was this “قَارِعَةٌ” (*qaari'ah*) which the *Quresh* tribe met due to their rebelliousness against the messenger and his companions, and this is the “الْقَارِعَةُ” (*al-qaari'ah*) which every nation that is rebellious will meet. This is seen nowadays due to the mutual conflict among nations. The details in surah *Al-Qaariah* include the clashes that will take place in this world as well as the accountability that will be conducted in the hereafter.

“الْقُرْعَةُ” (*al-qur'ah*): part, luck.

“الِقَاءُ الْقُرْعَةِ” (*ilqaa'ul qur'ah*): balloting {M}. The Quran does not use this word “قُرْعَةٌ” (*qur'ah*) to mean to draw straws or lottery.

In reference to *Maryam*, it is said:

3:43	They drew their ballots (through bows)	إِذْ يُلْقُونَ أَقْلَامَهُمْ
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The Jews used to decide many things by balloting. The bible mentions this. The Quran however advocates decision making by using the intellect and wisdom. It does not leave decision making to chance but makes them on a rational basis.

“الْقِرْفُ” (*al-qirf*): the bark of a tree, or the peel of a pomegranate, etc.
 “الْقِرْفُ مِنَ الْأَرْضِ” (*al-qiru minal-ard*): the crust of the soil which is uprooted along with the vegetables.
 “الْقِرْفَةُ” (*al-qirfah*): to obtain and earn.

Ibn Faris has said it means to wear something, or for something to be indiscriminately mixed with another.

“اِقْتَرَفَ” (*iqtaraf*): to earn.
 “اِقْتَرَفَ الْمَالُ” (*iqtarafal-maal*): He collected wealth.
 “رَجُلٌ قُرَفَةٌ” (*rajulun qurafah*): an earning man {T}.
 “اِقْتَرَفَ” (*iqtaraf*): to labour and earn whether the work is good or bad, but usually it has the connotation of doing bad work {R}.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:114	So that they may continue what they are doing. Let them be engaged in things they are busy in.	وَلْيَعْتَرِفُوا مَا هُمْ مُقْتَرِفُونَ
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“الْقَرْنُ” (*al-qarn*): the horn of an animal, or that part of a man's head where the animal has its horns, or the upper part of the head.
 “الْقَرْنُ مِنَ الْقَوْمِ” (*al-qarnu minal-qoum*): the head of a tribe or a nation {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means a thing that is highlighted or comes strongly and with intensity to the surface, and to gather one thing with another.

“الْقَرْنُ” (*al-qarn*): fixed period. There is difference of opinion as to how long this period is, but generally it is said to be a hundred years. Some say that some part of a period is called “قَرْنٌ” (*qarn*) and its limit is not fixed. Or it means contemporary or a nation which has been obliterated or occurred in the past.
 “الْقَرْنُ” (*al-qirn*): contemporary or equal {T}.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:6	former nations	أَلَمْ يَرَوْا كَمْ أَهْلَكْنَا مِنْ قَبْلِهِمْ مِنْ قَرْنٍ
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The plural of “قَرْنٌ” (*qarn*) is “قُرُونٌ” (*quroon*).

“الْقَرْنُ” (*al-qarn*): to tie something with another or to mix with it, or to tie two camels with one rope {T}.
 “قُرْنَتِ الْأَسَارَى فِي الْجَبَالِ” (*qurrinatil usaara fil hibaal*): the prisoners were rounded up and tied to a rope {T}.

The Quran says:

14:49	tied together in chains	مُقَرَّنِينَ فِي الْأَصْفَادِ
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“قَرْنُ الشَّيْطَانِ” (*qarnush shaitaan*): the disciples of the devil or his force {T}.
 “اِقْرَأْ لِلْأَمْرِ” (*aqrana lil amr*): He had a say in the matter. He had the capacity for some work {T}.

The Quran uses the word “مُقَرَّنِينَ” (*muqrineen*) in (43:13) to mean “those with power and authority”.
 “الْقَرِينُ” (*al-qareen*): companion, friend, tied together in one rope or in one cause {T}.

The Quran uses the word “قَرِينَةً” (*qareena*) to mean companion or friend in (4:38).

Muheet says “الْقَرِينَةُ” (*al-qarinah*) means wife.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* mentions “ذِي الْقَرْنَيْنِ” (*zulqarnain*) in (18:83). It has many recounts but modern research shows that it refers to a king *Kaikhusr* or Cyrus. His two horns or hats mean the two kingdoms of *Media* and *Faaris* that he ruled. About a hundred years ago, a statue was discovered from the ruins of *Istakhar* which has two horns on the head, because in Iran a country was represented by “قَرْنٌ” (*qarn*) or horn. This was the king who had delivered the Jews from Babylon’s dreadful captivity and at whose hands the predictions of the messengers *Daanial*, *Yasiah*, and *Yeremiah* were proven true. These predictions are present in the *Torah* even today. *Daanial* had dreamt of a hippo with two big horns. He was told by *Jibreel* that it was the king of two big states who would deliver the Jews from the Babylonians. This deliverer was famous by the name of *Zulqarnain* among the Jews.

Sir Percy Sykes has given the photo of this king Cyrus in his book “*A history of Persia*” in Volume 1.

In the predictions of the messenger *Yasiah* the man with the horns has been called *Khars*. So when this king *Khars* conquered Babylon and liberated the Jews, the messenger *Daanial* showed him or told him about this prediction of the messenger *Yasiah* which had been made about a 150 years back.

This king first moved towards the west from Iran and reached Lydia (a country of north west Asia minor) and conquering its capital *Sardas*, reached the sea coast where the sun could be seen setting (18:86). Later he went to *Bakhtar* (18:90). His third sojourn was towards the *Koh* pass where he built a wall so that the people of the south were protected from the attacks of the wild tribes of the north (18:94). These were the followers of king *Zartasht*. Quran has acknowledged the high character of this king (18:95-98). More details can be found in the book titled “*Barq-e-Toor*” and under the heading “*Zulqarnain*”.

However, these are the facts that modern research has been able to reveal until now. Some other facts that are revealed, may throw light on some other details. The reason that the Quran has mentioned king *Zulqarnain*, can be achieved even without determining historically as to which king is referred in the Quran.

Q-R-Y

ق ر ي

“الْقَرْيَةُ” (*al-qaryah*): big city, any city or any place where many dwellings are situated alongside each other {*T*}. Plural is “قُرَى” (*qura*).

Raghib says it means any place where people gather. It also means the people who gather {*R*}.

Muheet says that a walled city is called “الْمَدِينَةُ” (*al-madinah*) but “قَرْيَةٌ” (*qaryah*) and “بَلَدَةٌ” (*balдах*) are cities which are not walled {*M*}.

“قَرَى الْمَاءَ فِي الْحَوْضِ” (*qaral-ma’a fil hauz*): filled the pool, or collected water in a pool.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to collect and to congregate.

In surah *Al-Baqrah* “قَرْيَةٍ” (*qaryah*) has appeared to mean a dwelling. (2:259)

In surah *Al-Ambia* “قَرْيَةٍ” (*qaryah*) has come to mean the people of a dwelling.

In surah *Az-Zakhrif* “الْقَرْيَتَيْنِ” (*qaryatain*) has appeared which means the dwellings or the twin cities of *Mecca* and *Ta’if* (43:31). The dictionary has expostulated that whenever “الْقَرْيَتَيْنِ” (*al-qaryatain*) is said, these two cities of *Mecca* and *Ta’if* are meant {*M*}.

“قَسَرَهُ عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*qasarahu alal-amr*): he compelled him to it.
 “قَسَرَهُ” (*qasarahu*): he dominated him or overpowered him.
 “الْقَسُورَةُ” (*al-qasoorah*): Lion. It also means the hunter and archer {R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “overpowering with intensity”.

The Quran says:

74:51	They are running away from the lion (So that it may not eat them)	فَرَّتْ مِنْ قَسْوَرَةٍ
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“الْقِسُّ” (*al-qiss*): to demand something, to search for something.
 “فُلَانٌ قِسٌّ إِبِلٍ” (*fulanun qissu ibil*): that man is a scholar on camels, i.e. one who stays with camels all the time and is well aware of their habits and ways.

Raghib says that it actually means to struggle for something at night {R}.

“الْقِسِيُّ” (*al-qasees*): scholarly leader in knowledge about Christians (5:82).

Muheet says that it is a Hebrew word, and it means “*sheikh*”. Its rank is below that of the bishop in the Christian church hierarchy {M}.

“الْقِسْطُ” (*al-qist*): the part that is just, even or right {T}, or equal portion, quantity, luck {T, M}.
 “تَقَسَّطُوا الشَّيْءَ بَيْنَهُمْ” (*taqassatush shaiyi bainahum*): they divided it equally among themselves {T, M}.
 “قِسْطَاسٌ” (*qistaas*): Scales (26:182, 17:35).

According to the *Lata'if-ul-Lugha* it means the right scales or measurements, or the rightest scales.

“أَقْوَمُ الْمَيزَانِ” (*aqwamul mayazeen*): is used to mean “الْقِسْطُ عَدْلٌ” (*al-qistu adal*) which means fair justice.

The Quran says:

5:42	Then judge fairly between them	فَاحْكُم بَيْنَهُم بِالْقِسْطِ
7:29	Say, my Rabb has commanded justice (i.e. be just)	قُلْ أَمَرَ رَبِّي بِالْقِسْطِ
49:9	Then make peace between them with justice and act justly. Indeed Allah loves those who act justly	فَأَصْلِحُوا بَيْنَهُمَا بِالْعَدْلِ وَأَقْسِطُوا إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ الْمُقْسِطِينَ

But “قَسَطٌ” (*qasat*) and “يُقْسِطُ” (*yuqsitu*) also means to move away from the truth and to be oppressive {T}.
 In other words this word means the opposites. *Ibn Faris* shares this opinion.

In verse (72:15)

“قَاسِطُونَ” (*qaasitoon*): those who oppress, or those who are unjust (72:15).
 “مُسْلِمُونَ” (*muslimoon*) has been used against it in (72:14), i.e. a *Muslim* is one who is never unjust.
 “الْقَسَاطُ” (*al-qasatu*): for the neck to dry up.

As said before, “قِسْطٌ” (*qist*) and “عَدْلٌ” (*adal*) both mean justice but the fine difference in them is that “عَدْلٌ” (*adal*) would mean to do justice between two men, “قِسْطٌ” (*qist*) would mean to fulfil someone's rights in a fair manner.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:3	If you fear that you will not be able to fulfil the rights of the orphans and the women	إِنْ خِفْتُمْ أَلَّا تُقْسِطُوا فِي الْيَتَامَىٰ
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Here there is no question of measuring the rights against anyone. The question is of fulfilling the rights of women and orphans themselves.

Ahead it is said:

4:129	You do not have the capacity to do justice between the women.	وَلَنْ تَسْتَطِيعُوا أَنْ تَعْدِلُوا بَيْنَ النِّسَاءِ
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Here the question is of treating different women equally and hence “عَدْلٌ” (*adl*) is used.

Q-S-M ق س م

“قَسَمٌ” (*qasam*), “يُقْسِمُ” (*yaqsim*): to divide something in parts, or to divide.

“فَانْقَسَمَ” (*fanqasam*): it was divided into parts.

“الْقِسْمَةُ” (*al-qismah*): division {*Gharib-ul-Quran*}.

“قِسْمَةٌ ضَيْرَىٰ” (*qismatun zaiza*): unjust division (53:22).

The Quran says:

43:32	We have divided between them (apportioned between them) worldly accoutrements of life	نَحْنُ قَسَمْنَا بَيْنَهُمْ مَعِيشَتَهُمْ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا
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This does not mean that God blindly distributes sustenance. For its division there is a law, which says:

53:39	Man gets for whatever he strives	لَيْسَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ إِلَّا مَا سَعَىٰ
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This division that we see in this world is not according to the laws of Allah but is man-made.

“مَقْسُومٌ” (*maqsoom*): that which is divided (15:44).

“مُقَسِّمٌ” (*muqassim*): the divider (51:4).

“الْمُقْتَسِمِينَ” (*al-muqtasmeen*): those who divide among themselves (15:90).

“اِسْتَقْسَمُوا” (*igtassam*): to demand division.

In the era before Islam, animals were divided by using arrows or dices. The Quran has advised against it, because by doing this, man renders himself open to vagaries of chance rather than deciding on the basis of rationale. This is an insult to humanity. This is why gambling and balloting is not permitted. For gambling see heading (*Y-S-R*) and for balloting see heading (*Z-L-M*).

“قَسَمٌ” (*qasam*): reasoning and evidence {*Gharib-ul-Quran*}, or that which separates truth and falsehood.

56:76	The evidence that I am presenting, is a great evidence	وَإِنَّهُ لَقَسَمٌ لِّوَعْدُكُمْ عَظِيمٌ
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“أَقْسَمَ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*aqsama bish shaiyi*): to present something as the reasoning or evidence (90:1), but when these words are referring to common folk then it would mean ‘swearing’.

“يُقْسِمُ الْمُجْرِمُونَ” (*yuqsimul mujrimoon*): the criminals will swear (30:55).

About *Iblees* it is said:

7:21	He told them both by swearing.	وَقَامَهُمَا
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The *momineen* are wont not to swear but to present evidence and reasoning in support of their claims. The compensation for breaking a promise has also been fixed so that swearing is kept at a minimum.

“قَسْوَةٌ” (*qaswah*): for something to become hard.
 “قَسْوَةٌ” (*qaswatun*) or “قَسْوَةُ الْقَلْبِ” (*qaswatul qalb*) means heartless.
 “حَجَرٌ قَاسٍ” (*hajaroon qaas*): solid and hard rock.
 “أَرْضٌ قَاسِيَةٌ” (*arzun qaasiyah*): harsh land which grows nothing.
 “لَيْلَةٌ قَاسِيَةٌ” (*lailatun qaasiyah*): very dark night {T}.

Nawab Siddiq Kasan Khan says that the speciality of the root (**Q-S-W**) is that it denotes strength and congregation {R}.

The Quran says:

2:74	Then your hearts hardened after that So they are like rocks, or even harder	ثُمَّ قَسَتْ قُلُوبُكُمْ مِنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ فَهِيَ كَالْحِجَارَةِ أَوْ أَشَدُّ قَسْوَةً
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Here “كَالْحِجَارَةِ” (*kalahijrah*) means hard like rocks, rather even harder than them.

Surah *Al-Hajj* says:

22:53	Whose hearts are hard, or who are unrelenting	وَالْقَاسِيَةِ قُلُوبُهُمْ
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In surah *Az-Zumr*, this has been explained by saying that they are the opposite of those:

39:22	whose chests are opened by Allah (to accept Islam)	مَنْ شَرَحَ اللَّهُ صَدْرَهُ لِلْإِسْلَامِ
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As such the “قَسَاوَتٌ” (*qasaawat*) of the heart would mean to stick to one’s wrong stance without deliberating and thinking about what is said and thus become unable to hear and accept that which is right. This is what dogmatism is. See heading (**Sh-R-H**) and (**Sd-D-R**).

“الْقَشَاعِرُ” (*al-qusha’ir*): that which is harsh and rough to touch {T}.
 “إِفْشَعَرَ جِلْدَهُ” (*aqsharrah jilduhu*): his skin started palpitating, shivering {T}.

Aqrab-al-Muwaarid says it metaphorically means “out of fear”.

Surah *Az-Zumr* says:

39:23	It sends a shiver down their spine	تَفْشَعُرُ مِنْهُ جُلُودٌ--
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“قَصَدَ” (*qasd*): to intend, to be attentive, to proceed towards something and to stand up for it, whether this is done moderately or not.

“الْقَصْدُ فِي الْأَمْرِ” (*al-qasu fil amr*): to be moderate in some matter.

“قَصَدَ فُلَانٌ فِي مَشْيِهِ” (*qsada fulanun fi mashihi*): he adopted a moderate stance in his speed.

“سَفَرًا قَاصِدًا” (*safaran qaasidan*): moderate in journey (9:44).

“الْقَصْدُ” (*al-qasdu*), “الْتَقَصِيدُ” (*at-taqseed*): to cut something in middle or to break something into two {T}.

“اِقْتَصَدَ فِي أَمْرِهِ” (*iqtasada fi amrihi*): he was stolid and moderate or did not get distracted this way or that.

“الْقَصْدُ” (*al-qasd*): for the way to be straight and clear {T}.

The Quran says:

16:9	To make the truth clear, (evident or straight) is Allah's responsibility	عَلَى اللَّهِ قَصْدُ السَّبِيلِ
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He has done so and only He can do so. But people adopt the wrong way instead of taking the right path. If “على” (*ala*) is taken to mean the same as “إلى” (*ila*) in this verse, then it would mean that the path to Allah is the ‘middle’ path. Not those paths which are crooked and lead one astray.

Raghib says that “اِلْتِقَاصًا” (*al-iqtisaad*) is of two kinds. One is completely virtuous and its two ends are positive and negative which are given up and the middle path adopted.

“وَأَقْصِدْ فِي مَشْيِكَ” (*waqsid fi masheek*): adopt moderation in your walk or in your affairs, because neither speed nor slowness is good in walk (31:19). But in the other kind of moderation is that one end is good and the other end not. That is, like justice and oppressiveness and injustice. A man who fluctuates between these two ends is called “مُقْتَصِدٌ” (*muqtasid*) {R}.

Raghib's words need consideration. At one end is wastefulness and at the other end is miserliness. Both these extremities are bad. The good way is between the two, i.e. neither to be a big spender nor be miserly. This moderation is laudable. Take another example. On one end is the truth and at the other end falsehood. Only one end here is good, not the other. Thus to be in the middle here is no big deal. Only he is laudable who adopts the path of the truth, not moves in between. The truth is stolid in its place. He who moves one inch away from it adopts falsehood.

Take another example. On one side is justice and at the other end is oppression or injustice. He who adopts justice is laudable but the person who adopts the middle way between justice and oppression is sometimes just and sometimes not, or is neither just nor oppressive. This means that if he is indifferent, then that person's deed is not laudable. Only those come up to the Quranic criterion will always do justice.

An example is found in surah *Al-Faatir* where it has been said:

35:32	We have selected one nation for being heir to our book and there are some who excel in virtues	فَمِنْهُمْ ظَالِمٌ لِّنَفْسِهِ وَمِنْهُمْ مُقْتَصِدٌ وَمِنْهُمْ سَابِقٌ بِالْخَيْرَاتِ
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See also (5:66).

This group among the three mentioned above is the best obviously, while those who do injustice are the worst. But between them is a group which does proceed in either virtuous deeds or evil. This will be better than the oppressive group but below the third. Its modus operandi will not be laudable, according to Quranic criterion. Only those who do justice will fulfil the Quranic criterion.

These examples make it clear that as it is generally said that such and such nation is moderate, is not right. Islam is the path of truth, and not the middle path between the truth and falsehood. The righteous nation is one which adopts the way of truth, not which moves in between truth and falsehood. See heading (*W-S-Te*), for the meaning of “وَسَطًا” (*wast*).

“الْقَصْرُ” (*al-qasr*), “الْقِصْرُ” (*al-qisr*): not to be long or lengthy, but to keep within some limit.
 “الْقَصْرُ” (*al-qasr*): to stop, to limit within some boundary.
 “صَرَ الشَّيْءُ” (*qasarash shaiyi*): to shorten the length of something.
 “قَصَرَ الشَّعْرُ” (*qasarash shair*): shortened the hair {*T, R*}.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:101	shorten the <i>salaat</i>	أَنْ تَقْصُرُوا مِنَ الصَّلَاةِ
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Ibn Faris has two basic meanings for this root. One is for something to reach its peak or limit, and second is to stop, to imprison.

“إِمْرَأَةٌ مَقْصُورَةٌ” (*imra atun madsurah*): veiled woman, or a woman who observes veil.
 “الْمَقْصُورَةُ” (*al-maqsurah*): a vast house or a small room surrounded or protected by walls {*T*}.

About the women in Quranic societies, the Quran says:

55:72	Safely kept in tents	مَقْصُورَاتٌ فِي الْخِيَامِ
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They have also been called “قَاصِرَاتُ الطَّرْفِ” (*qaasiraatit tarf*) which means “those who keep their eyes lowered or within bounds due to shyness, or those who do not let their eyes be brazen” (37:48) {*T*}.

“الْقَصْرُ” (*al-qasr*): thick pieces of woof for burning as fuel. It also means the roots of trees {*T*}.
 “قَصَرَ عَنِ الْأَمْرِ” (*qasara ban al-amr*): to abstain from something.
 “قَصَرَ عَنْهُ” (*qsara unhu*): when a man is unable to do something, or not capable of doing it {*Ibnus Sakeet*}.
 “أَقَصَرَ عَنْهُ” (*aqasara unhu*): when the capability is there but one abstains from doing it {*T*}.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:202	They do not stop, never are lacking	لَا يُقْصِرُونَ
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Surah *Al-Fath* uses “مُقَصِّرِينَ” (*muqassireen*) in (48:27) which means “those who get their hair cut”.
 “قَصَرَ سَهْمُهُ عَنِ الْهَدَفِ” (*qasara sam-uhi unil hadaf*): his arrow failed to reach the target {*T*}.
 This makes the meaning of “تَقْصِيرٌ” (*taqseer*) clear, that is “fault”.

“قَصَّ أَثَرَهُ” (*qassa asarahu*), “يَقْصُ” (*yaqussu*), “قَصًّا” (*qassan*), “قَصَصًا” (*qasasa*): to follow in someone’s footprints {T}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is to follow and to struggle. (28:11, 18:64).

“قَصَّ عَلَيْهِ الْخَبَرَ قَصَصًا” (*qassa alaihil khabara qasasa*): told him the news, made him aware of it {T}.

The Quran says:

12:3	We narrate to you events in the best way	نَحْنُ نَقُصُّ عَلَيْكَ أَحْسَنَ الْقَصَصِ
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“الْقَاصُّ” (*al-qaassu*): story teller.

A hadith says “إِنَّ بَنِي إِسْرَءِيلَ لَمَّا قَصُّوا بَلَكُوا” (*inna bani israeela lamma qassu halaku*) which means “when *Bani Israel* fell into storytelling, they were destroyed”, or “they were destroyed when they gave up God’s way and started following their ancestors”. The same thing happened with the *Muslims*.

“الْقِصَّةُ” (*al-qissah*): news, matter, event {T}.

“قَصَّ الشَّعْرَ” (*qas shas shair*): he cut hair.

“الْمِقْصُ” (*al-miqassu*): scissors.

“الْقِصَاصُ” (*al-qisaas*): to pursue a criminal and see that he is punished for his crime, or to punish a criminal for his crime, or for a law to pursue criminals.

Raghib says it means compensation for murder.

The Quran has used it to mean the punishment for murder. Since this is an important topic let us discuss it in detail.

According to the Quran, human life is so important that it has said:

5:32	He who commits murder, except in exchange for a life or as a punishment for spreading chaos in society, is like he has murdered the entire mankind	مَنْ قَتَلَ نَفْسًا بِغَيْرِ نَفْسٍ أَوْ فَسَادٍ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَكَأَنَّمَا قَتَلَ النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا
5:32	He who saves a soul is like he has saved the entire humanity.	وَمَنْ أَحْيَاهَا فَكَأَنَّمَا أَحْيَا النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا

This shows that according to the Quran, murder is a serious crime. Anyone who commits murder or spreads mayhem in the country can be punished by being killed.

About the chaos in the country there are orders contained in (5:33), but since we are not discussing that topic here, we can leave it to latch on to our main topic of individual murder.

About the crime of murder the first verse is in surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:178	Compensation for murder has been made mandatory on you.	كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْقِصَاصُ فِي الْقَتْلِ
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In this verse “قصاص” (*qasaas*) is generally taken to mean the punishment of death, but this is not right. As stated earlier, “قصاص” (*qasaas*) means to pursue someone. Therefore “قصاص” (*qasaas*) means to pursue the criminal or to follow him, not to let him go scot free so that he is punished for his crime. The *momineen* have been addressed in this verse to do this job.

If a society does not have collective method to fight crime then the punishment of the crime is left to individuals who have been affected. For example if a man is murdered, it is incumbent upon the heirs of the murdered man to pursue the criminal, and avenge themselves, and if the criminal is beyond their reach, then just sit tight and be unable to do nothing in the matter. But the Quran presents a collective system in which it is not left to the individuals to avenge the crime. It tells the society that the crime is against the society itself, and not just against the heirs of the murdered one. Therefore, it is the duty of the

society and not of the heirs of the murdered, to make the criminal pay for his crime. It is incumbent upon the society to avenge the affected individuals. In modern day language it may be said that the Quran has made murder a crime in which the police can intervene and in this the prosecution is the responsibility of a state. Therefore it is the duty of the Islamic government to pursue the criminals and do justice.

Ahead it is said:

2:178	Free man for free man, <i>abid</i> for <i>abid</i> , and female for female	الْحُرُّ بِالْحُرِّ وَالْعَبْدُ بِالْعَبْدِ وَالْأُنْثَىٰ بِالْأُنْثَىٰ
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This part of this verse relates an important principle that in this matter let not the position of the murderer or the murdered have any relevance. No matter how important the murderer is, and however lowly the murdered, because both are equal in the eyes of the law. This because every human life, be that of a free man or slave man or woman, is equally important.

This does not mean that if a free man “حُرٌّ” (*hur*) has been murdered then a “حُرٌّ” (*hur*) may be killed in exchange, even if the murderer is a slave. It does not mean that if the murdered is a slave then a slave should be hanged for the murder, even if the murderer is a free man. The Quran has stressed the principle of general equality here and said that only he who is the murderer should be punished, regardless if that person is a free man or a slave.

Further ahead it is said:

2:178	He who has been pardoned by his brother (heir of the murdered one), should try to fulfil his obligation honestly	فَمَنْ عُفِيَ لَهُ مِنْ أَخِيهِ شَيْءٌ فَاتَّبَاعْ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَأَدَاءٍ إِلَيْهِ بِإِحْسَانٍ ذَلِكَ تَخْفِيفٌ مِّن رَّبِّكُمْ وَرَحْمَةٌ
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There is reduction and benevolence from your Sustainer. There is no mention of punishment here, but rather reducing the punishment is mentioned. “To be forgiving” shows that it is not connected to the punishment by death, because there is no letting up even a little in a death sentence. To forgive somewhat can be done when the punishment is monetary. This is called “ديت” (*diyat*).

The crime of murder is mentioned also in surah *An-Nisa* where punishments according to the different types of crimes are mentioned. It is said:

4:92	And he who kills a <i>momin</i> by mistake must free a slave and pay compensation to the heirs of the murdered man, except if they pardon the murder	مَا كَانَ لِمُؤْمِنٍ أَنْ يَتَّكِلَ مُؤْمِنًا إِلَّا خَطَاً
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This makes it clear that murder by mistake is not punishable by death but compensation is required which will be given to the heirs of the murdered man. The monetary value will be fixed by the court, and the heirs of the murdered man have been given the right to pardon some or all of the money. As such the verse (2:178) has said that murder by mistake is punishable by compensation.

The verse (4:92) says about a case where the murdered man is from amongst your enemy or one with which you have a pact. In this case too, compensation has been proscribed.

The next verse says:

4:53	And he who murders a <i>momin</i> wilfully then his punishment is <i>jahannam</i> in which he will stay and the wrath of Allah will befall him and a severe punishment has been prepared for him.	وَمَنْ قَتَلَ مُؤْمِنًا خَطَاً فَتَحْرِيرُ رَقَبَةٍ مُّؤْمَنَةٍ وَدِيَةٌ مُّسَلَّمَةٌ إِلَىٰ أَهْلِهِ إِلَّا أَنْ يَصَدَّقُوا
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Here the Quran has said that a first degree murder or intentional murder is punishable by extreme punishment. There is no compensation or blood money here. Although there can be different types even in intentional murder. For example a man cold bloodedly contemplates that if such and such man is killed then all his property will come to me. He prepares a scheme and murders the man according to a well thought out scheme. This sort of crime should have the harshest possible punishment. Another example is that of a man who finds that his wife’s chastity is being violated or threatened. He is chagrined and murders the attacker in anger. This too is intentional murder but there is a gulf of difference between this and the first example. Therefore, every intentional murder will not incur the same sort of punishment.

Punishment will differ as per the crime. This leads one to the thought that by saying “جَزَاؤُهُ جَهَنَّمُ” (*jaza-u’hu jahannam*). Allah’s wrath, his insult and disregard are all different forms of punishments, for example, sole imprisonment, rigorous imprisonment, solitary confinement, disqualifying one from rights enjoyed by other members of the society, etc.

It is possible that some may think that here the punishment is to be received in *jahannam* and not in this world. But at another place, this has been clarified by God himself. It has been said that the punishment for wilful murder is generally death.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:33	Do not kill him whom God has forbidden (who is innocent)	فَلَا تَقْتُلُوا النَّفْسَ الَّتِي حَرَّمَ اللَّهُ إِلَّا بِالْحَقِّ
17:33	If somebody is killed unjustifiably then let not the murderer think that there is no supporter or backer of the heirs of the murdered	فَمَنْ قُتِلَ مَظْلُومًا فَقَدْ جَعَلْنَا لَوْلِيٍّ سُلْطَانًا

Hence a person should not think that because of this he can be brazen and he will not be held accountable for the murder. He should not have this false concept. God has made the entire society as a whole the supporter of the heirs of the murdered and it will help in avenging the murder.

17:33	Thus the society will definitely end up avenging the murder	إِنَّهُ كَانَ مُنْصُورًا
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But the society has also been admonished not to exceed the limit in punishing the criminal by death.

For instance a man kills four or five people of a family. After the crime is established the court, despite being angered at this crime, is not allowed to punish excessively by allowing four or five people of the murderer’s family to be hanged, because that will be wasteful murder.

Nor does this part of the verse mean that the heir of the murderer has the right to kill the murderer.

The orders for “قصاص” (*qasaas*) are for the society or society’s set up and not for the individuals. They are not allowed to take the law into their own hands. The crime of murder is crime against the society. The position of the heirs of the murdered is, because the society will be the prosecution. As such “فَلَا يُسْرِفُ فِي الْقَتْلِ” (*fala yusrif fil qatl*) is also for the society or its justice system.

Thus two things are hereby clarified.

“وَمَنْ قُتِلَ مَظْلُومًا” (*waman qutila mazluma*) means to deliberate murder, because in a murder by mistake the murderer will not be called the oppressor and the murdered as a person on whom oppression is perpetrated. He who commits murder due to some mistake or error is not the oppressor. Rather he is ashamed of what he has done. Therefore the murdered will be called “مظلوم” (*mazloom*) only when somebody has deliberately murdered him.

The powerful in society must not believe that due to their being powerful they can murder at will and that nobody will hold them accountable. The entire social power will be behind the heirs of the murdered and will help him avenge the death of his near and dear one.

The punishment for deliberate murder is death, but the limit will not be crossed in this too.

When this verse is read along with that of surah *An-Nisa*, that is “ذَا فَلَا يُسْرِفُ فِي الْقَتْلِ” (*fajaza’u’hu jahannamu*) then it will be explicit that their *jahannam* would mean the punishment of death, and ‘the wrath of Allah’ would mean greater punishments that the society will determine.

The above show that according to the Quran.

- The crime of murder is a crime against humanity.
- The crime of murder is not a crime against the individual but a crime against a society. Therefore, pursuing the criminal and punishing him is a duty of the society not the individual.
- It will be the court that will decide whether it was wilful murder or by mistake.
- If it is murder by mistake, then the punishment will be compensation.
- The heirs of the murdered have the right to pardon the murderer fully or reduce the amount of compensation.
- In wilful murder the punishment is not compensation, and therefore the heirs have no right and the court will decide the punishment, which can be death penalty or according to the circumstances something less than that, like life imprisonment etc.
- The statement that no **momin** is wont to murder another **momin** except erroneously does not mean that a **momin** can go around killing those who are not **momins**. Not at all. The life of a **momin** and a non-**momin** are sacrosanct similarly (5:32) but **momins** are each other's brothers and it does not befit a brother, no matter how peeved he may be, to kill his brother, but this can happen by mistake. In such a case, he will have to pay compensation, so that he is careful against such mistakes in future. But if a **momin** kills another **momin** deliberately, then that will incur the harsh **punishmen** of death.

The Quran while giving extreme value to life, has acknowledged that murders can take place, i.e. life can be taken where truth and justice so demands. That is, as punishment for the murder of an innocent, or in battle with the enemy, or to stop those who create chaos or mayhem in an Islamic society. But this too as to how life can be justly taken will be made by the society or the court, and not by any individual.

Therefore, not even the heirs of the murdered victim have the right to kill the murderer themselves. This is the form of "قِصَاصٌ" (*qisaas*) that Quran says, in which the collective good of your society lies (2:179).

Q-Sd-F ق ص ف

"قَصَفَ" (*qasafa*), "يَقْصِفُ" (*yaqsaf*) and "قَصْفًا" (*qasfa*): to break something.
 "رَعْدٌ قَاصِفٌ" (*raadun qaasif*): a harsh boom.
 "الْقَصِيفُ" (*al-qaseef*): dried and broken parts of a tree, or anything which has broken into two halves.
 "عَصَفَتِ الرِّيحُ فَقَصَفَتِ السَّفِينَةَ" (*asafatir reehu faqasafatis safeenah*): strong winds blew and broke the boat {T}.

The Quran says:

17:69	Such strong winds as would break the boat	قَاصِفًا مِنَ الرِّيحِ
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Lataif-ul-Lugha says that "الْعَوَاصِفُ" (*al-awaasif*) are those winds which stir up a storm in plains and deserts and "الْقَوَاصِفُ" (*al-qawasif*) are the winds which whirl up a storm in seas.

Q-Sd-M ق ص م

"قَصَمَ" (*qasama*), "يَقْصِمُ" (*yaqsimu*), "قَصْمًا" (*qasma*): to break something, whether it separates after breaking or not {F}.
 "هُوَ أَقْصَمُ النَّبِيِّ" (*huwa aqsamu sanniiah*): his front tooth is half broken.
 "سَيْفٌ قَصِيمٌ" (*saifun qaseem*): the sword with a dull blade or broken (dull) sharpness {R}.
 "قَصَمَهُ اللَّهُ" (*qasamahullaahu*): May Allah demean him {R}.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says:

21:11	We have demeaned many habitations into ignominy (destroyed them as a punishment for their crimes)	وَكَمْ قَصَمْنَا مِنْ قَرْيَةٍ
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“قَصَاعَةً” (*qasa unhu*): he went away from him, or was distanced from him.
 “قَصَا الْمَكَانُ” (*qasal-makaan*): the place became distant, or was distanced from him.
 “قَصِيٍّ” (*qasiyyiah*): far or distant. The plural is “أَقْصَاءُ” (*aqsa*).
 “الْقُصْوَى” (*al-quswa*): far to the farthest limit, or very far {*T, M, R*}.
 “بِالْعُدْوَةِ الْقُصْوَى” (*bil-udwatil quswa*): at the far end (8:42).
 “مَكَانًا قَصِيًّا” (*makaan qasiyya*): a distant place {*T, M, R*}.
 “الْمَسْجِدُ الْأَقْصَى” (*al-masjidil aqsa*): very distant mosque. Commonly it means **Bait-ul-Muqaddas** in Jerusalem, but we think it means the city of **Medina** which is about three hundred miles away from **Mecca** and where the Messenger migrated and which was to become the place of “سجده” (*sajdah*), that is, for the group of **momineen**. In other words, it became a “مسجد” (*masjid*) or a centre of the Islamic System established within the the Quranic values.

Q-Zd-B

ق ض ب

“قَضَبَ” (*qazabah*): he cut him off.
 “فَانْقَضَبَ” (*fanqazab*): so he was cut off.
 “قُضَابَةُ الشَّيْءِ” (*quzaabatush shaiyi*): the part which is cut off from the whole, or that which breaks off from the branches of a tree.
 “الْقَضْبُ” (*al-qazb*): the branches of a tree which are cut from a tree for making bows and arrows, or the tree wood which is used to make arrows and bows, or every tall and spread out tree {*T*}.

Raghib says that the branches of a tree are called “قَضِيبٌ” (*qazeeb*) and the branches of vegetables are called “قَضْبٌ” (*qazb*).

The Quran says “عَنْبًا وَقَضْبًا” (*enaban wa qazban*) in (80:28) which means vegetables.

Faraa says that those who lived in **Mecca** used to call a type of fodder as “قَضْبٌ” (*qazb*).

Q-Zd-Zd

ق ض ض

“قَضَّ” (*qazza*), “يَقْضُ” (*yaquz*), “قَضًّا” (*qazza*): to beat something or drill a hole into it.
 “قَضَّ الْوَتِدَ” (*qazzal-watid*): he uprooted the stake.
 “الْقَضَّةُ” (*al-qazzah*): small pellets of stone, or that which breaks off from them.
 “انْقَضَّ الْجِدَارُ” (*anqazal-jidaar*): the wall developed a crack but it has not fallen down until now {*R*}. But **Ibn Faris** and **Taj** both say that it means that the wall fell.

The Quran says:

18:77	The wall that was about to fall down.	جِدَارًا يُرِيدُ أَنْ يَنْقَضَ
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Ibn Faris says that the root has three basic meanings

- 1) For something to fall down
- 2) For a thing to be uneven and rough
- 3) To drill a hole into something.

Surah **Al-Kahaf** has used this word to mean “fall down”.

“الْقَضَاءُ” (*al-qaza'u*) has many different meanings. But the basic meanings are for something to be cut off, or de-linked as well as to be completed {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to make something more steadfast and take it ahead on the path it should go.

“الْقَضَاءُ” (*al-qaza*): to separate and cut off {R}.

“قَدْ قَضَىٰ دَيْنَهُ” (*qad qaza deenahu*): he paid back the debt fully and thus ended his obligation to the lender.

“الْقَضَىٰ” (*al-qaziyyu*): death.

“قَضَىٰ إِلَيْهِ” (*qaza ilaih*): took the matter to its end {T}.

“الْقَضَاءُ” (*al-qaza*): to create something fully and to fix its proportions. It also means to make something explicitly clear {T}.

“الْتَقَاضِي” (*al-taqazi*): to demand {T}.

The Quran says about God:

2:117	When he has decided about something or he makes a decision	إِذْ أَقْضَىٰ أَمْرًا
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Surah *Taha* says that the sorcerers of the Pharaoh said:

20:72	you can decide what you wish	فَأَقْضِي مَا أَنْتَ قَاضٍ
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Surah *Al-Qasaas* says that *Moosa* hit a “” (*qubti*) with his fist which caused his death:

28:15	sent him to death, or terminated his life	فَقَضَىٰ عَلَيْهِ
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A little ahead is said that *Moosa* said to his father-in-law:

28:28	Whichever time period among the two I complete	إِنَّمَا أَلاَ جَلَيْنِ قَضَيْتُ
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Surah *Az-Zakhrif* uses this word against “مَكْتٌ” (*maks*) which means “to endure”, therefore “يَقْضُ” (*yaqz*) in (43:77) would mean “to terminate”.

Since the decisions of God regarding the human world reach humans through the Divine Revelation:

15:66	We sent the revelation to him (let him know about our final verdict through the revelation)	وَقَضَيْنَا إِلَيْهِ
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The Quran says:

17:4	We had sent this decision to the <i>Bani Israel</i> via this book	وَقَضَيْنَا إِلَىٰ بَنِي إِسْرَائِيلَ فِي الْكِتَابِ
17:37	Your Sustainer made the order known to the humans through the revelation	وَقَضَىٰ رَبُّكَ أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِلَٰهًا
28:44	When we sent the revelation to <i>Moosa</i> .	إِذْ قَضَيْنَا إِلَىٰ مُوسَىٰ
41:12	thus created many planets out of it (created them and fixed their proportions)	فَقَضَيْنَاهُنَّ سَبْعَ سَمَوَاتٍ
6:2	Allah is the one who created you from earth and made it proportionate (fixed a time period for the humans on earth)	هُوَ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ طِينٍ ثُمَّ قَضَىٰ أَجَلًا
2:36	Hence you will stay on this earth for a time and benefit from it for a time	وَلَكُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ مُسْتَقَرٌّ وَمَتَاعٌ إِلَىٰ حِينٍ
40:20	Allah decides justly	وَاللَّهُ يَفْضِي بِالْحَقِّ
19:21	Decided matter, fixed law.	أَمْرًا مَّقْضِيًّا

“الْقَطْرُ” (*al-qatar*): drops, or a thing which is formed by drops like rain. Singular is “قَطْرَةٌ” (*qatrah*).
 “سَحَابٌ قَطُورٌ” (*aahaban qurtur*): a cloud which rains very profusely.
 “الْقِطْرُ” (*al-qitru*), “الْقَطِيرُ” (*al-qatir*): melted copper or some kind of copper (18:96) {T}.
 “الْقَطِرَانُ” (*al-qatiraan*), “الْقَطْرَانُ” (*al-qatra nural*): saliva or a kind of sticky liquid which is prepared by heating the sap from *sanobar* trees (14:50) {T}.
 “الْقُطْرُ” (*al-quṭr*): end, towards, corner. The plural is “أَقْطَارٌ” (*aqtaar*) which also means environs as used in (55:33).

Ibn Faris has said that this root does not follow any defined pattern.

“الْقَطُّ” (*al-qatt*): to cut something width-wise.

Ibn Faris has added “to cut fast” in the basic meaning of this root.

“قَدَّ” (*qadd*): cutting length-wise
 “إِنْقَطَّ الشَّيْءُ” (*inqattash shaiyi*): a thing was cut {T}.
 “الْقِطُّ” (*al-qitt*): a fixed portion (that was cut and separated), or a scroll on which the award for somebody is written. In other words, it may mean any written scroll. Some say that the book of accountability is called “قِطُّ” (*qitt*).

The Quran says:

38:16	O my Sustainer, decide quickly about us (i.e. sort out our punishment quickly)	رَبَّنَا عَجِّلْ لَنَا قِطًّا
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It also means the portion or the book of accountability.

“قَطَعَ الشَّيْءُ” (*qatash shaiyi*): cut that thing off.

Raghib says it can also be applicable to things which are visible to us.

“قَطَعَ اللَّحْمُ” (*qatal-lahm*): to cut meat. It is also said for things which are figuratively cut.
 “قَطَعَ السَّبِيلَ” (*qata'us sabeel*): to commit dacoity and cut off communications.
 “قَطَعَ لِسَانَهُ” (*qata'a lisaanuhu*): to shut somebody off by doing him a favour {M}.

The Quran says (figurative meaning):

2:27	they break Allah's Covenant after it is ratified	يَقْطَعُونَ مَا أَمَرَ اللَّهُ بِهِ أَنْ يُوصَلَ
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In other words, they cut off the links of humanity which God has ordered to be kept connected, or divide the humanity into parties.

“قَطَعَ خَصْمَهُ بِالْحُجَّةِ” (*qata'a khashmahu bil hujja*): he overpowered the opponents with his reasoning {T}.
 “قَطَعَ رَحِمَهُ قَطِيعَةً” (*qata'a rahimhu qatee'ah*): he cut himself off from his relatives.
 “أَقْطَرَعَهُ” (*uqtua'h*): the thing which is sent to signify cutting off of relations {F}.
 “قَطَعَ عَنْقَ ذَا بَنِي” (*qata'a unuqa dabbatihi*): does not mean that he actually slaughtered his animal but that he sold it off {T}.
 “قَطَعَتْ لِسَانَهُ” (*qute'at lisaanuhu*): that the tongue which used to wag incessantly did not so remain {T}.
 “قَطَعَتْ يَدَهُ” (*qute'at yaduhu*): his hand due to some ailment became useless {T}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:31	And cut their hands .. (i.e. their hands stopped from what they were doing)	قَطَعْنَ أَيْدِيَهُنَّ
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This means that their hands stopped working, or in surprise they injured their hands.

“قَطَّاعُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*qutt at-tareeq*): highway robbers {*T*}. The Quran says this in context of *Loot's* nation.
 “قَطَعَ السَّبِيلَ” (*qata'us sabeel*): or in this verse “تَقَطَّعُوا السَّبِيلَ” (*taqta-oonas sabeel*) means to close the way for human regeneration unnaturally (29:29).
 “قُطِعَ بِهِ” (*quti'a bihi*): something intervened between him and his hopes. He became disappointed.
 “قُطِعَ مِنَ اللَّيْلِ” (*qit'un min al-lail*): The part of night which is from the first part of the night to the third part. The last part is also so called {*T*}. See (11:81).

Ibn Faris says it means any part of the night.

“قُطِعَ الرَّجُلُ” (*quti-ar rujul*): that man lost hope and became vulnerable {*M*}.
 “قَطَعَ الْأَمْرَ” (*qata'al-amar*): To decide ultimately.

27:32	I am not one to make the last decision in any matter	مَا كُنْتُ قَاطِعَةً أَمْرًا
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Surah *Al-Maidah* says about theft:

5:38	cut off their hands	فَأَقْطَعُوا أَيْدِيَهُمَا
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But it can also mean ‘adopt some way whereby their hands desist from stealing’. This meaning is supported by the remainder of the verse:

5:38	This is the punishment for them (thieves) as from Allah as a deterrent (i.e. taking measures to deter others to resort to stealing)	جَزَاءٌ بِمَا كَسَبُوا نَكَالًا مِنَ اللَّهِ
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For the meaning of “نَكَالًا” (*nakalan*) see heading (*N-K-L*). That is, adopt measures whereby their hands desist from stealing.

Ahead it is said:

5:38	and the criminal who is repentant for his crime and reforms himself should be forgiven	فَمَنْ تَابَ مِنْ بَعْدِ ظُلْمِهِ وَأَصْلَحَ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ يَتُوبُ عَلَيْهِ
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Now this repentance could be after or before the punishment is given to him. But if his hands are cut off as punishment then what can be achieved by forgiving him? On the other hand, if “أَيْدِي” (*aidi*) is taken to mean “authority”, then “قَطَعَ يَدَ” (*qata yud*) would mean to withdraw that authority, or ability which enables someone to steal. This encompasses all sorts of misappropriation. See heading (*N-D-Y*).

Surah *Al-Mai'dah* says ahead about the rebels of the state:

5:33	Kill them or put them on the cross, hang them, expel them from the country or cut their hand and feet from the opposite direction.	أَنْ يُقْتَلُوا أَوْ يُصَلَّبُوا أَوْ تُقَطَّعَ أَيْدِيهِمْ وَأَرْجُلُهُمْ مِنْ خِلَافٍ أَوْ يُنْفَوْا مِنَ الْأَرْضِ
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Here besides putting them on a cross or hanging them or killing them, the punishment of “قَطَعَ أَيْدِي وَ أَرْجُلَ” (*qataee aid wa arjul*) is also present or mentioned. It can also mean to imprison them with the opposite sides (hands and feet) in shackles i.e. with handcuffs and leg irons. The very same words have been used for punishing the sorcerers of the *Pharaoh's* court.

“قطع يد” (*qata yad*) can also be taken to mean ‘adopt some way so that the stealing hands can be made to desist from stealing’. We too sometimes say that by signing that document you have cut off your hands, i.e. thereby that you have become helpless by doing so i.e. bound by an agreement.

If “قطع يد” (*qata yad*) actually means to cut off the hands then it is an extreme sort of punishment which can be adopted only when these crimes become frequent and there is no other way to stop them excepting awarding this punishment. Like smuggling has become so common in recent years that it has become incumbent to award harsh punishment for this crime in order to deter them. The border police is therefore authorized to shoot smugglers at sight. Although death penalty can be awarded only for deliberate murder or mutiny, but even this is after that the accused is provided with full opportunity to defend himself and if the crime is proven beyond doubt. Under these circumstances stealing can be punished by cutting the hand and feet, or when the system of Allah is prevalent in a society and everyone’s needs are taken care of by a society. To steal in such conditions can verily be punished severely *{T}*. Some say dacoits and robbers are also included in this punishment.

Not to establish an Islamic system and even then to punish a thief by cutting off his hand and leg is to implement Allah’s system in part and not look at the whole. The result of which is mentioned in (2:85).

Q-Te-F ق ط ف

Ibn Faris says this root basically means for something to break off (especially for picking fruits from trees).

“الْقُطْفُ” (*al-qitf*): a recently picked bunch of grapes. The plural is “قُطُوفٌ” (*qutuf*).
 “الْمِقْطَفُ” (*al-miqtafu*): the scissors with which fruits are cut off from branches *{T}*.

The Quran says:

69:23	Their bunches grow close together	قُطُوفُهَا دَانِيَةٌ
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Q-Te-M-R ق ط م ر

“الْقِطْمِيرُ” (*al-qitmeer*): the breach or gap in the seed of the dates, or the thin membrane that covers the date seed. This word is spoken to mean a small thing *{R}*.

The Quran says:

35:13	They do not enjoy even a little authority	مَا يَمْلِكُونَ مِنْ قِطْمِيرٍ
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“الْقُعُودُ” (*al-qu’ud*): to sit. It is the plural of “الْقَاعِدُ” (*al-qaid*) which means “he who sits”.
 “الْمَقْعَدُ” (*al-maq’ad*): to sit and also the bottom (which one uses to sit on). The plural is “مَقَاعِدُ” (*miqaa’id*).
 “قُعُودُ” (*qu-ud*) and “جُلُوسٌ” (*julus*) are of the same meaning. Some say that “قُعُودُ” (*qu-ud*) means to sit down while standing, and “جُلُوسٌ” (*julus*) means to sit while lying down or getting up from prostration and sitting. Some scholars say “قُعُودُ” (*qu-ud*) means to sit enduringly (tight). The foundations of a house are called “قَوَاعِدُ الْبَيْتِ” (*qawa-idul bayt*), not “جَوَالِسُ الْبَيْتِ” (*jawalisul bayt*).
 “الْقَاعِدَةُ” (*al-qa’idah*): the root or foundation on which a building is built. The plural is “قَوَاعِدُ” (*qawa’id*).
 “أُقْعِدَ الرَّجُلُ” (*uqedar rajul*): he was bedridden and due to sickness lost the ability to sit or walk.
 “قَعَدَ لِلْحَرْبِ” (*qa’ada lil herb*): he prepared the braves who would fight in the battle {*T*}.

Zajaaj says that “قَوَاعِدُ الْبَيْتِ” (*qawa’idul bayt*) means the columns on which a building stands {*T, M, R*}. The Quran has used “الْقَوَاعِدُ مِنَ الْبَيْتِ” (*alqawa’id minal-bayt*) in (2:127), and used it against “قَعَدَ اِنْبِعَاطٌ” (*qa-ada unbi’aas*) in (9:46).

Surah *Al-Buruj* says:

85:6	When they were sitting or ready (to do battle)	إِذْ هُمْ عَلَيْهَا قُعُودٌ
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Raghib says that one who is lazy in doing something is called “قَاعِدٌ” (*qaa’id*) {*R*}.

In (4:95) “الْقَاعِدُونَ” (*al-qaidoon*) has appeared against “الْمُجَاهِدُونَ” (*al-mujahidoon*) in these meaning.
 “الْقَاعِدُ” (*al-qa’eed*): a man who gives you company, sits with you like an overseer (51:17) {*T*}.
 “الْقَاعِدُ” (*al-qaa’id*) or “مِنْ النِّسَاءِ” (*minan nisaa’i*) is an old woman who has lost hope of menstruation, a husband or a child. The plural is “الْقَوَاعِدُ” (*alqawaid*) or “مِنْ النِّسَاءِ” (*minan nisaa’i*) (24:60).
 “مَقَاعِدُ” (*maqa’id*): central places (3:120).

Surah *Al-Qamar* says:

54:55	A place where all the pleasantries of life are present	فِي مَقْعَدٍ صِدْقٍ
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See heading (*Sd-D-Q*). But this place (*jannat*) is only a place to sit i.e. a transitory place not a place for permanent abode.

Surah *Al-Jinn* (for the supply houses of *Jinns* and astrologers) says:

72:9	The place for listening	مَقَاعِدَ لِلْسَّمْعِ
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“الْقَعْرُ” (*al-qa’ar*): the ultimate depth of anything.
 “قَعْرُ الْبَيْرِ” (*qa’reul biyr*): the depth of a well.
 “قَعْرُ النَّخْلَةِ” (*qa’aran nakhlah*): he uprooted the date palm.
 “فَانْقَعَرَتْ” (*fanqa’arat*): so it was uprooted {*T, R*}.

The storm that engulfed the nation of *Aad* was so strong that it uprooted everything:

54:20	As if they were uprooted date palms	كَأَنَّهُمْ أَعْجَارٌ نَّخْلٍ مُنْقَعِرٍ
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One meaning is that they seemed like they were already uprooted, and also that they were being pulled out of their roots as if they had shallow roots, i.e. that nation thought itself to be very established. It thought that it was so deep set that nobody could uproot it, but a single storm destroyed it.

Surah *Al-Haqqah* says:

69:7	Like hollow tree trunks	أَعْجَارٌ نَّخْلٍ خَاوِيَةٍ
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“قَفَلَ” (*qafal*), “يَقْفُلُ” (*yaqfilu*), “يَقْفُلُ” (*yaqfal*), “قَفُولًا” (*qufula*): for somebody to return from a journey.

Some think that “قَفُولٌ” (*qufool*) means for the army to return from a war.

“أَقْفَلَ الْجَيْشُ” (*aqfalal-jaish*): the army returned.

“الْقَافِلَةُ” (*al-qaafilah*): those companions of the journey who are returning {*F*}. But those going on a journey are also so called with the hope that they will return safely, or hoping for their safe return they are called “الْقَافِلَةُ” (*qaafilah*), even while going on the journey {*T, R*}.

“قَفَلَ الطَّعَامُ” (*qafalat tuaam*): he stored foodstuff.

“قَفَلَ الشَّيْءَ” (*qafalash shaiyi*): he estimated a thing.

“أَقْفَلَ الْبَابَ” (*aqfalal-baab*): He closed the door.

“الْقِفْلُ” (*al-qufl*): lock which is used to lock the door {*T, R*}.

“اسْتَقْفَلَ الرَّجُلُ” (*istaqfalar rajul*): that man was a miser.

The Quran says:

47:24	their hearts (and minds) are locked, so that they do not think rightly	أَمْ عَلَى قُلُوبٍ أَقْفَالُهَا
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“الْقَفَا” (*al-qafa*), “الْقَافِيَةُ” (*al-qaafia*): the back of the neck.

“الْقِفْوَةُ” (*al-qifwah*): the tail. It also means accusation.

“قَفَوْتُهُ قَفْوًا” (*qafautuhu qafwa*): I followed him.

“قَفَيْتُهُ زَيْدًا” (*qafiyatuhu zaida*): I sent him after Zaid.

“هُوَ قَفِيَّتُهُ” (*huwa qafiyatuhu*): he is his heir {*T, R*}.

“الْقَفِيَّةُ” (*al-qafiyah*): also means superiority {*T, R*}.

Ibn Faris too says it means to follow someone.

Surah *Al-Hadeed* says:

25:57	Then we sent more messengers after them	ثُمَّ قَفَّيْنَا عَلَى آثَارِهِمْ بِرُسُلِنَا
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Also see (3:87)

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:36	And do not pursue a thing if you do not have knowledge about it (i.e. acquire knowledge first). Remember that the sight, the hearing, the mind, will all be questioned as to their use	وَلَا تَقْفُ مَا لَيْسَ لَكَ بِهِ عِلْمٌ إِنَّ السَّمْعَ وَالْبَصَرَ وَالْأَفْئِدَةَ كُلُّهُ لَآتٍ لَكَ فَاسْأَلْ عَنْهُ مَسْئُولًا
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Great facts have been related in this verse. The first thing is that without deliberating just out of custom or tradition, one should not continue to do something. One should undertake research himself. The other thing is the Quran has emphasised that knowledge should have evidence of the eyesight (observation) and hearing. Knowledge can accrue through hearing and sight. This is perceptual knowledge, and whatever information sight and mind relay to the mind, should not lead to conclusions through emotions (i.e. no personal bias) but through reasoning within the permanent values. Provide any possible information about everything and then conclude dispassionately using the Quran as a criterion.

Raghib too says while explaining this verse that it means not to make decisions based on guesswork or speculation. He says “قِيَافَةٌ” (*qiyafah*) is actually derived from “اِقْتِفَاءً” (*iqtifaa*) i.e. speculating.

“قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*) basically means to keep turning something up and down, or to keep changing a thing.
 “قَلَبَ الشَّيْءَ يُقَلِّبُهُ” (*qalabash shaiya yaqlibhu*): to turn and overturn a thing, or to keep turning upside down.
 “قَلَّابٌ” (*qallaba*) also has this meaning as above but with exaggeration.
 “تَقَلَّبَ” (*taqallaba*): to turn from side to side like a snake does on hot hand.
 “قَلَبَ الْخُبْزَ” (*qalab al-khubz*) is said when the bread has been cooked on its surface and is being overturned to cook it from its inside too.
 “مِقْلَابٌ” (*miqlab*): the piece of iron which the farmer uses to turn over the earth for cultivation {T}.

Since man's heart too is never the same and keeps changing, it is called “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*), and since intellect and insight also look at things from all angles (or turn them over and inspect them) and then form a conclusion, they are also termed “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*).

Ibn Hashaam has mentioned four of the meanings of “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*):

- Heart.
- Intellect.
- The synopsis of everything
- The best part of anything.

Ibn Faris describes two basic meanings of this root.

- The pure or unadulterated or valued part of anything
- To turn one thing from facing one way to another.

The Arabs say “هَذَا عَرَبِيٌّ قَلْبٌ” (*haaza arabiiyun qalb*). This man is a pure Arab.

Kitaab-al-Ashfaaq says that every pure thing is called “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*).

The Quran has used two words “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*) and “فُؤَادٌ” (*fuwaad*).

“فُؤَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) is derived of “فَادَ” (*fa'ad*), which means to roast or heat up. These two words differ broadly in that “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*) is the source of intellect and deliberation, and “فُؤَادٌ” (*fuwaad*) is the depository of emotions.

Surah **Al-Airaaf** says about the dwellers of **jahannam** that they are the people who:

7:179	They do have <i>qalb</i> but do not use it for understanding	لَهُمْ قُلُوبٌ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ بِهَا
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Surah **Al-Kahaf** says:

18:57	Their <i>qulub</i> are covered by veils and therefore they are unable to understand	إِنَّا جَعَلْنَا عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ أَكِنَّةً أَنْ يَفْقَهُوهُ
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Surah **Al-Hajj** says that “قَلْبٌ” (*qalb*) is used to mean to understand (22:46)

Surah **An-Nahal** says:

22:46	Defrauding or misleading intellects	لَهُمْ قُلُوبٌ يَعْقِلُونَ بِهَا
16:22	Their hearts refuse to understand	قُلُوبُهُمْ مُنْكَرَةٌ

See heading (**N-K-R**). Also see headings (**S-M-Ain**) and (**B-Sd-R**) where *qalb* is meant as being the source of intellect and insight.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says about the hypocrites:

2:9	They do not deceive anyone else excepting themselves but do not understand this.	وَمَا يَخْدَعُونَ إِلَّا أَنْفُسَهُمْ وَمَا يَشْعُرُونَ
2:10	their minds are sick i.e. do not understand the implications of their conduct	فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ مَرَضٌ

Here the adverse condition of both the mental and psychological condition is meant. This shows that the Quran has used the word *qalb* to mean both intellect and emotion. Therefore the English word 'mind' can be meant both by *qalb* and *fuwaad*. In the Quran too both these words have been used for alternate meanings. See heading (F-A-D).

“تَقَلُّبٌ” (*taqallub*) has been used to mean struggle (40:4, 16:46).

The Quran says:

26:18	When you stand (in prayer) before them who genuflect before God, then he watches you	الَّذِي يَرْتُكَّ حِينَ تَقُومُ وَتَقُوبُكَ فِي السَّاجِدِينَ
2:144	When you are looking towards the heavens eagerly time and again (in expectation) We do watch your inner state ...	قَدْ نَرَى تَقَلُّبَ وَجْهِكَ فِي السَّمَاءِ

Therefore “تَقَلُّبٌ” (*taqallub*) would mean both physical and mental states affected by the circumstances and the challenges faced by individuals/groups

“مُنْقَلَبٌ” (*munqalabun*): a place to return to (18:36).

“مُنْقَلِبٌ” (*munqalib*): one turns back.

The Quran says:

9:48	(These people kept on planning to) upset matters for you (they kept on scheming as how to spoil your plans)	وَقَالُوا لَكِ الْأُمُورُ
18:42	He was left wringing his hands	يُقَلِّبُ كَفَّيْهِ
47:19	The time or place to be engaged in struggle	مُنْقَلَبِكُمْ

Q-L-D ق ل د

“قَلَدَ الْحَبْلُ” (*qalan nahabl*): wound the rope.

“الْإِقْلِيدُ” (*al-iqleed*): the nose ring of the camel through which a rope is passed in order to rein it.

“الْمِقْلَادُ” (*al-miqlaad*): key as well as treasure. The plural is “مَقَالِيدُ” (*miqaleed*) {T, M}.

The Quran says:

93:63	All the treasure in the highs and lows of the universe belongs to God.	مَقَالِيدُ السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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“الْقِلَادَةُ” (*al-qilaadah*): necklace. The plural is “الْقِلَادُ” (*al-qila'idu*).

The Quran says:

5:2	Nor of the animals brought for sacrifice nor the garlands that mark out such animals	وَلَا الْهَدْيَ وَلَا الْقَلَائِدَ
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Raghib says “قِلَادَةُ” (*qilaadah*) means a winded string or silver strand which is worn around the neck but later it came to mean anything which was worn around the neck or which encircles anything i.e. surrounds it {R}.

This helps us comprehend the meaning of “تَقْلِيدٌ” (*taqleed*), that is, a collar around our neck with the leash in someone else's hands and then to follow it like a dog.

“تَقْلِيدُ الْوَلَاةِ الْأَعْمَالِ” (*taqleedul walatil aamaal*): for the bosses to designate various servants to various functions {T, M}.

Muheet says that “التَّقْلِيدُ” (*at-taqleed*) means the beliefs and customs for the Jews and the Christians which are nowhere mentioned in their holy books but which they have heard of from their elders and follow them for centuries.

The Quran has made its advent to free man of the shackles of personality cults which hung around his neck like millstones and which he was following like slaves (7:156). So the messenger **Muhammed** with the help of the Quran broke these shackles into pieces, but after him the **muslims** again gathered these shackles together and hung them around their neck more tightly than before. This is “تَقْلِيدٌ” (**taqleed**) that destroys man’s faculty of freedom of thought and deed. The Quran invites man to conquer the universe and not to be enslaved to humans or their beliefs. “تَقْلِيدٌ” (**taqleed**) is the worst form of slavery because in slavery only man’s body is enslaved while in “تَقْلِيدٌ” (**taqleed**) man’s faculty of thought is also enslaved i.e. it leads to egocentric thinking where people feel comfortable with their false beliefs and do not wish to question them.

The Quran calls for the use of intellect and reasoning at every step and cautions against the blind following of the ways of our elders or for that matter others. In fact, it says that this is done by those who deny the permanent values. It says that whenever a messenger called people towards God, he was opposed by people saying that whatever he taught went against what their elders believed and they would follow (even blindly) their elders and not the revelation.

Nooh was the first to get this reply from the people (33:24). **Saleh** too got the same response (11:61-62). **Ibrahim** was told the same (21:53). **Shoaib** got the same reply (11:87) and **Moosa** too (10:78). The last messenger **Muhammed** was given the same response (38:7). In short, every messenger was opposed on the same grounds (43:23-24). It was only opposed on the grounds that its teachings went against that of their forefathers (2:170, 5:104).

The Quran says that this is not the way the humans should behave as they have been endowed with intellect and reasoning where they can make choices. It is like animals that cannot make decisions and follow their natural instincts. As such in the life of **jahannam**, one is living more in the past (33:66-67). He is unable to see forward (36:8-9), and the past seems bright to these people as a result their future is bleak (59:18).

This is precisely the state of the nations including the Muslims who do not critically reflect on their backwardness and underdevelopment. Those who have the Quran oppose it on the grounds that it is against the beliefs of their forefathers. The Quran invites us to check and assess all beliefs in the light of the permanent values and then accept these for their optimum results. The reasoning that the elders had understood the Quran and then believed and we need to follow what they believed is rejected by the Quran, which invites us repeatedly to reflect as of today. The reason for this is, that the life is about going forward and as the technology develops and scope of the human intellect widens the Quran helps us to relate to its values to help us develop our mind further (41:53). The reference to the past is only to learn lessons. The Quran is preserved till the last day for this very reason, and every generation is invited to reflect into the Quran so that they could find out for themselves what the Quran has said regarding the higher purpose of human creation. The criterion for right and wrong is the Quran as it deals with the human intellect and the reasoning processes and provides guidance in making optimum choices within the permanent values.

Q-L-Ain ق ل ع

“قَلَعَ” (**qala**), “قَالَعَ” (**qalla’a**), “اِقْتَلَعَ” (**iqtala**): uproot a thing from its base and to remove it from its place.
 “الْمَقْلُوعُ” (**al-maqlooh**): a dethroned leader.
 “الْقَلْعُ” (**al-qal’u**): the safe place where the shepherd keeps his belongings.
 “الْقَلْعَةُ” (**al-qal’ah**): the date plant which is uprooted from near the date tree.
 “الْإِقْلَاعُ عَنِ الْأَمْرِ” (**al-iqlaa’u unil amar**): to stop from doing something {**T, M**}.

The Quran while relating about the storm of **Nooh** says:

11:44	the rain was directed to stop raining	يَسْمَاءُ أَقْلَعِي
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“الْقُلُّ” (*al-qull*): little, meagre.
 “الْقِلَّةُ” (*al-qillah*): it is the opposite of abundance, shortage.
 “قُلٌّ” (*qalla*), “يَقِلُّ” (*yaqillu*): to be meagre.
 “قَلِيلٌ” (*qaleelun*): little
 “أَقْلَهُ قُلَّةً” (*aqllahu qallalah*): reduced it.
 “الْأَقْلُّ” (*al-aqullu*): very little {T}.
 “الْقُلَّةُ” (*al-qullah*): the head, the hump or the upper part of the mountain. It also means party {T}.
 “الْقِلَّةُ” (*al-qillah*): the shivering that is due to greed or anger {T}.
 “اسْتَقَالَ الرَّجُلُ” (*istaqalar rajul*): that man got up in anger.
 “اسْتَقَلَّهُ” (*istaqallahu*): Lifted him, elevated him.
 “اسْتَقَالَتِ السَّمَاءُ” (*istaqallatis sama'i*): the sky became high.
 “الْإِسْتِقْلَالُ” (*al-istaqlaal*): to be lofty, to stand on one's own feet, or to make something special for oneself.
 “هُوَ لَا يَسْتَقِيلُ بِذَا” (*huwa la yastaqillu bihaaza*): he is incapable of it, or he cannot lift it {T}.
 “قُلٌّ” (*qalla*): to be little.
 “مُنَاعٌ قَلِيلٌ” (*mata-un qaleel*), “قَالًا” (*qallala*): to reduce (3:196, 8:44).
 “أَقْلًا” (*aqalla*): to lift {T} (7:57) i.e. to lift it thinking it to be lightweight.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are for something to be little and not to stay in one place.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of “قَلَمٌ” (*qalm*) is to pare something to make it smooth.

“الْقَلَمُ” (*al-qalam*): the pen with which we write. It also means scissors, or an arrow without any feathers at the tail and without any blade, or those arrows which were used in gambling (game of chance). The plural is “أَقْلَامٌ” (*aqlaam*).

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says that the Jewish scholars used to draw ballots for fending for Maryam in (3:43). Here “أَقْلَامٌ” (*aqlaam*) means this.

At other places “أَقْلَامٌ” (*aqlaam*) means pens with which one writes:

68:1	By the pen and what it writes	وَالْقَلَمِ وَمَا يَسْطُرُونَ
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Muheet says a pen is only called “قَلَمٌ” (*qalam*) when it is pared to work as a pen. Before that it is called either “يَرَاعَةُ” (*yara'tun*) or “قَصَبَةٌ” (*qasabatun*). These words show that the Arabs in those days could write. The Quran itself says when you are dealing with each other then write it down (2:282)

Consider the verse of surah *Al-Alaq* in which it is said:

96:4	Allah is the one who taught man through pen	الَّذِي عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ
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Here written knowledge is emphasized, and secondly God cannot directly teach man through a pen. Therefore, the meanings of this verse and others like it mean that God has endowed man with the ability to acquire such knowledge. If this point is kept in mind, it will greatly in understanding the Quran where the human actions are related to Allah.

“الْقِلَى” (*al-qila*): the intensity of enmity and prejudice.

Ibn Faris says that it means to move away from something and to go away from it.

“قَلَى يَقْلَى” (*qala yuqli*): have enmity against someone and to express extreme dislike and to part with him.

“قَلَى يَقْلَى” (*qala yuqli*): part with someone.

“قَلِيَهُ يَقْلَاهُ” (*qaliyah yuqlahu*): have enmity.

Actually “قَلَى” (*qalyun*) means to roast meat, etc.

Ibn Faris says it means to be light and fast.

“قَلَاهُ” (*qalahu*): he fried it in the pan.

“الْقَلَاءُ” (*al-falla'u*): one who makes pans.

“الْمِقْلَاةُ” (*al-miqlah*): zinc or earthen pan used for frying meat etc. {T, M, R}.

The Quran says about the Messenger:

93:3	Your Sustainer has neither abandoned you nor is annoyed with you	مَا وَدَّعَكَ رَبُّكَ وَمَا قَلَى
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In surah *Ash-Shura* Loot's statement is related:

26:168	I am extremely annoyed with your deeds. (I do not want to have anything to do with you)	إِنِّي لِعَمَلِكُمْ مِنَ الْقَالِينَ
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“قَمَحَ الْبَعِيرُ قُمُوْحًا” (*qamahal-ba-eeru qumuha*): camel raised his head at drinking place and refused to drink.

“قَامَحَتْ إِبِلُكَ” (*qaamahat ibiluka*): your camels did not drink despite having come to the drinking place and stood with their heads raised.

“أَقَمَحَ الرَّجُلُ” (*aqmahar rajul*): that man raised his head but lowered his eyes.

“أَقَمَحَ الْغُلَّ الْأَسِيرُ” (*aqmahal-ghul lul aseer*): due to the shackles being narrow the prisoner was forced to keep his head raised {T, M, R}. In that era shackles also had a collar around the neck.

36:8	Their heads are tense and raised.	فَهُمْ مُقْمَحُونَ
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Actually “قَمَحٌ” (*qamh*) means wheat, while ground wheat made from it is called “قَمِيْحَةٌ” (*qameeha*). For eating the ground wheat one has to raise the head, and this is called “الْقَمْحُ” (*qamhu*). Later it meant to raise the head no matter for what reason {T, M, R}.

“الْقَمَرُ” (*al-qamar*): the moon from the third to the 25th night. First, second, and the moon of the 26th night is called “بِلَالٌ” (*hilaal*) {T}.

“تَقَمَّرَ الْمَرْأَةُ” (*taqamaral-mar'ah*): wedded a woman and took her away. It also means to spend a conjugal night at full moon.

Raghib says these meanings are derived from “قَمَرَهُ” (*qamarahu*) which means to overcome. As such the moon is called “قَمَرٌ” (*qamar*) because its light overcomes that of other stars {R}.

“قَمَرْتُ فَلَانًا” (*qamatu fulana*): I deceived that man {R}.

“الْقِمَارُ” (*al-qimaar*): gambling.

“الْقَمِيرُ” (*al-qameer*), “مَقَامِيرُ” (*muqamir*): Gambler {M}.

Gharib-ul-Quran says that in the pre-Islamic era the national symbol of the Arabs was the moon, or “قَمَرٌ” (*qamar*). Just as the national symbol of the Persians was the sun.

The Quran has said:

54:1	The hour is approaching and the <i>qamar</i> is about to tear apart	إِقْتَرَبَتِ السَّاعَةُ وَانْشَقَّ الْقَمَرُ
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It actually means that a clash between the *momins* and the Quresh is imminent. See heading (*S-W-Ain*). At that time Arabia's dark era will end and the flag of the Islamic Sytem established with the permanent values will be raised for the good of mankind. See heading (*Sh-Q-Q*)

75:9	And <i>shams</i> and <i>qamar</i> gets joined	وَجُمِعَ الشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ
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It points to the Arabs and the Persians being together which took place after the *muslims* conquered Persia. If in this verse “شَمْسٌ” (*shams*) and “قَمَرٌ” (*qamar*) are literally taken to mean the sun and the moon then their physical changes seem to be the case. About this we can't say anything definitely.

“قَمَصَ الْفَرَسُ” (*qamasal-farasu*), “يَقْمُصُ” (*yaqmusu*), “يَقْمِصُ” (*yaqmissu*), “قَمَصًا” (*qamsan*) and “قِمَاصًا” (*qimaasa*): for a horse to raise its forelegs together and then bang them together on the ground.

“الْقِمَاصُ” (*al-qimaas*): to jump or to hop. It also means repentance and tribulation.

“الْقَمُوصُ” (*al-qamoos*): the animal which starts jumping with the rider on its back.

“الْقَمِصُ” (*al-qamees*): a mule which jumps too much {T}.

Ibn Faris says that it has two basic meanings. One is to don something and wrap oneself in it. The second meaning is for something to jump and move.

“قَمَصَ الْبَحْرُ بِالسَّفِينَةِ” (*qamasal-bahru bis safeenah*): the river waves made the boat rock {*Maqabees-ul-Lugha*}.

“الْقَمِصُ” (*al-qamees*): The shirt which one wears. In the Arabic language this word is masculine but sometimes it is used as a feminine too. The plural forms are “قُمُصٌ” (*qumus*), “أَقْمِصَةٌ” (*aqmisatah*) and “قُمَصَانٌ” (*qumsaan*):

Ibnul jazri says that “الْقَمِصُ” (*al-qamees*) means a sewn cloth which has two sleeves and which is not open from below. This cloth or garment is made of stuffed cotton. If the garment is made of stuffed wool then it can't be called “قَمِصٌ” (*qamees*). It is not that such shirt cannot be made of wool at all, although often it is not made of wool.

“الْقَمِصُ” (*al-qamees*) also means a thin membrane over the heart {T}.

The Quran says in relation to **Yusuf**:

12:93	(Yusuf said) take my shirt and put it before my father (as a sign). He will comprehend the whole matter	إِذْهَبُوا بِقَمِيصِي هَذَا فَأَلْقُوهُ عَلَى وَجْهِ أَبِي يَأْتِ بَصِيرًا
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In those days and even today, the dress of the high ranking people has held importance and is the way of showing their higher status with a social heirarchy. The shirt of **Yusuf** was a symbol of his high rank. Thus he sent his shirt to his father so that with his shirt he would know the high rank that his son **Yusuf** had attained.

But this verse can have another meaning. Earlier it has been said that:

12:84	Due to crying over Yusuf , his father Yacoob's sight became weak	وَابْيَضَّتْ عَيْنَاهُ مِنَ الْحُزَنِ
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Later **Yusuf's** "قَمِيصٌ" (*gamees*) was presented before him. This caused a psychological effect and his senses became strong due to which his sight improved. Sometimes immediate good news causes this psychological change. In the narrative of **Yusuf**, the shirt or "قَمِيصٌ" (*gamees*) is first mentioned when his brothers douse it in blood and brought it to their father (as a proof of **Yusuf's** death) (12:18). The second time his shirt is used to prove his innocence (12:26-27) and the third time as the proof of his being alive and his status.

"قَمَصَه" (*qammasahu*), "قَمِيصًا" (*gameesan*), "فَتَقَمَّصَ" (*fataqammas*): he made him wear the shirt and he donned it. Some scholars say that if the opening for the head in the shirt is on the chest then it is called "دِرْعٌ" (*dir'un*) but if it is on the shoulders, then it is called "قَمِيصٌ" (*gamees*) {*T*}. "الْقُمَاصُ" (*al-qumaas*) is a camel disease which makes the camel restless and it cannot stand still {*T*}.

Q-M-T-R ق م ط ر

"الْقِمَاطِرُ" (*al-qimatar*): a wooden leg shackle which was used to be put on the prisoner's legs so that he couldn't escape {*T, M, R*}. This used to cause the prisoners much pain in moving about. Later this word came to mean pain and trouble. Due to the pain, the creases that form around the eyes and the eyebrows were called "قَمَطَرِيرٌ" (*qamtreer*).

"إِقْمَاطِرُ الْيَوْمِ" (*iqmattaral-yaum*): the day became harsh.

"شَرُّ مُقْمَاطِرٍ" (*sharrun muqmatirrun*): Severe evil {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran calls the time when the results are made known as:

76:10	a period of great harshness and trouble	يَوْمًا عَبُوسًا قَمَطَرِيرًا
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Ibn Faris too says this is the basic meaning of this root.

”الْمِقْمَعَةُ“ (*al-miqma'ah*): an iron weight lift, or an ankus or the weapon that is used to kill an elephant. Its plural is ”مَقَامِيعُ“ (*muqaamih*) {T, M, R}.

The Quran says about those in *jahannam* i.e. state of hell:

22:20	They will have iron bails to restrain them from escaping the law and the implementing force (57:25)	وَهُمْ مَقَامِيعُ مِنْ حَدِيدٍ
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”قَمَعَ“ (*qamah*), ”قَمَعًا“ (*qamaa*): he overcame him, and demeaned him.

”قَمَعَ فُلَانًا“ (*qama'a fulana*): he stopped him from his intent.

”الْمَقْمُوحُ“ (*al-maqmuh*): insulted, treated meanly {T, M, R}.

”مَقَامِيعُ“ (*maqamih*): the force with which a rebel is prevented from rebelling. It also means to make the oppressor helpless by overpowering him and thus make those who are oppressed safe from his oppression (22.20).

Ibn Faris says that it basically means to demean or overpower someone.

”الْقُمَّلُ“ (*al-qamuloon*), ”الْقُمَّلُ“ (*qummalu*): small ants or lice (7:133). Some say this is an insect which infests crops and causes destruction {T}.

Kishaaf has said that it means pest and *Raghib* says it means small flies.

Ibn Faris says that some words are derived from its root whose basic meaning denote insult and hatred.

”قَنَتَ“ (*qanat*): to stand up and to stop speaking.

Zajaaj says that ”قَاءَمَ بِأَمْرِ اللَّهِ“ (*qa-imun bi amrillah*) means the same as ”قَانِيتُ“ (*qaanit*) which means someone who establishes the laws of Allah, or someone who stands up with the laws of Allah to implement them {T}.

”سِقَاءٌ قَنِيتُ“ (*siqa'un qaneet*): a canter that holds water without wasting a drop {T}. Therefore its right meaning would be to preserve one's strength and to use it only according to Allah's guidance. This sort of obedience is called ”الْقُنُوتُ“ (*al-qunut*) {T}.

Muheet says it means to do something with preparation and with endurance {M}.

The Quran says about things in the universe:

2:116	Nothing among them wastes its energy and uses it according to Allah's law	كُلٌّ لَهُ قَانِشُونَ
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All are busy in fulfilling the Will of Allah, i.e. as ordained by Allah. All are engaged in sustaining the system of the universe. This same attribute is found in *momin* men and women.

33:35	They are all <i>qanit</i> men and women	الْقَانِتِينَ وَالْقَانِتَاتِ
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About *Ibrahim* it is said:

16:120	He was not a mere individual but a complete nation was hidden within his person.	كَانَ أُمَّةً قَانِتًا لِلَّهِ
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He represented a nation which stands up with an invitation towards Allah and uses all its forces and strength towards this invitation, in other words a completely obedient nation.

Ibn Faris says it basically means obedience. For this subject see heading (A-M-M).

Q-N-Te

ق ن ط

“الْقَنْطُ” (*al-qanat*): to prevent.

“قَنْطَ مَاءً عَنَّا” (*qanata ma-un unna*): he stopped the water to us.

“الْقُنُوتُ” (*al-qunoot*): to lose hope.

“قَنْطَ يَقْنُتُ” (*qanata yaqnut*), “قَنْطَ يَقْنِيتُ” (*qanata yaqnit*), and “قَنْطَ يَقْنُتُ” (*qanita yaqnat*): to be desperate.

“قَاءَانِيتُ” (*qaanit*): someone who loses hope {T} (15:55-56).

The Quran has used “يُنُوتُ” (*yu'aus*) and “قُنُوتُ” (*qanut*) together in (41:49)

Surah *Az-zamar* says:

39:53	Say: O my servants who have transgressed their own selves, despair not the mercy for Allah; for Allah's system has protection for all acts and He is all protecting and His guidance can help in the self development (see next verse 39:54)	قُلْ يَا عِبَادِيَ الَّذِينَ أَسْرَفُوا عَلَىٰ أَنفُسِهِمْ لَا تَقْنَطُوا مِن رَّحْمَةِ اللَّهِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَغْفِرُ الذُّنُوبَ جَمِيعًا إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ
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Some people have taken this verse as a sort of license for committing crimes , because Allah's mercy and forgiveness will pardon all this.

This concept is clearly against the teachings of the Quran that it needs no further explanation. The Quran has indeed , through this verse (39:53) refuted the Christian concept that man is born a sinner and this sin can never be absolved. And there is only one way to atone for it and that is by believing in the atonement of Jesus. The Hindu religion also believes that nothing can atone for a sin once committed. For this sin man has to be involved in the rebirth in different forms. The Jews too have the concept that the sin committed by their forefathers by worshipping the calf will send them to *jahannam* or hell for some time.

The Quran refuted the theory that a human child is born with the sins of his parents upon his shoulders. If ever a man commits a sin, then it doesn't make him a sinner forever. He can always recover from its effects by doing righteous deeds. So anyone who wants Allah's forgiveness can always do so. But how do the doors to this path open and how does one know that this has been forgiven or if he has the required protection? At another place this question is answered by the Quran itself:

15:56	doors to kindness and forgiveness are closed only to those who give up the path of Allah and adopt other paths	وَمَنْ يَقْنُتْ مِن رَّحْمَةِ رَبِّهِ إِلَّا الضَّالُّونَ
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Thus one who adopts the path defined by the Quran, gets the protection and mercy as explained in the book. The Quran has sign posted both paths clearly and explained through examples of the messengers and the righteous as models. The quran clearly states that if they could do it through their own choice so can others. The practical way for this is:

11:115	Mitigate the destructive effects of errors and mistakes with life giving results of righteousness	إِنَّ الْحَسَنَاتِ يُذْهِبْنَ السَّيِّئَاتِ
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For more details, see heading (R-H-M).

Surah *Ar-Rom* mentions “قَنْطُ” (*qanita*) against “فَرَحُ” (*fariha*) in (30:36).

Lataif-ul-Lugha says “يَأْسُ” (*yaas*) commonly means hopelessness, while “قُنُوتُ” (*qunut*) means a more intense type of hopelessness.

“الْقَنْطَرَةُ” (*al-qantara*): bridge or tall building.

“قَنْطَرٌ عَلَيْنَا” (*qantara alaina*): He stayed with us for a long time {T}. This word has a connotation of abundance.

Raghib says “الْقَنْطَرَةُ مِنَ الْمَالِ” (*al-qantaratul minal-maal*) means that unascertained quantity of wealth which is enough for somebody {R}. The plural is “الْقَنْطَارِيرُ” (*al-qanaateer*).

“الْقَنَا طَيْرُ الْمُقَنْطَرَةِ” (*al-qanateerul muqantarah*): the wealth which has been collected bit by bit (3:13) {R}. This includes a connotation of painstakingly, i.e. very much {M}.

In this verse (3:13), wealth is said to have attraction and temptation for man. The Quran does not advocate hatred for wealth. It does implore every man to come up to the accountability regarding wealth, but not confine his wealth to himself. He should use what is required to meet his needs and to spend the rest for the good of mankind. As a corollary to this verse, a *momin's* character has been described as “الْمُنْفِقِينَ” (*al-munfiqeen*), i.e. those who keep their wealth open (for others). The Quran emphasises this point repeatedly i.e. to keep it available for common good. Those who do not do so, have been promised painful punishment e.g. (9:34), that is, wealth hoarded becomes the cause for going to *jahannam*.

“قِنَاعٌ” (*qina*): the covering with which women cover their heads {T}.

Raghib says anything which is used to cover the head is “قِنَاعٌ” (*qina*).

“قَنَعَ” (*qaania*): that man put something on his head in order to hide his poverty {R}.

“قَانِحٌ” (*qaanih*): a person who does not disclose his poverty or need to others.

“الْقَنَاةُ” (*al-qanaati*): hiding of needs.

Raghib says “قَنَعَ” (*qana'a*) means that she lifted her cover and exposed her head i.e. bared her head, or revealed her needs to others. But “قَنُوحٌ” (*qunuh*) also means to be content with what a person gets, and to become happy with even a little bonus.

“الْقَانِحُ” (*al-qaanih*): a person who stays with someone (in his employment), and doesn't demand too much from him.

“قَنَاعَةٌ” (*qana'ah*): to be happy with little {T}.

“قَانِحٌ” (*qaanih*): a beggar who is happy with what he gets and does not insist on more {R} (22:36).

Ibn Faris says it means to refer to others to meet one's needs.

“اِقْنَاعٌ” (*iqnaah*): to walk with head raised or high.

“اَقْنَعَ رَأْسَهُ” (*aqna'a raasahu*): he raised his head. But this word has opposing meanings as well. It also means to lower.

“اَقْنَعْتُ الْإِنَاءَ فِي النَّهْرِ” (*aqnatul ina-i fin nahr*): I put my vessel against the flow of the water so that it could be filled with water. This word is also spoken to mean to be attracted towards somebody.

“قَنِعَتِ الْإِبِلُ” (*qaani'atul ibil*): the camels were inclined towards their grazing lands or their pen {T}.

In surah **Ibrahim**, the Quran has depicted the condition that engulfs a defeated nation. Their condition is such that:

14:43	Racing ahead with heads raised	مُهْطِعِينَ مُنْجِعِي رُؤُسِهِمْ
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“مُهْطِعِينَ” (*muhti-eena*): to scamper in a disturbed state. See heading (**H-Th-Ain**).

“مُنْجِعِي رُؤُسِهِمْ” (*muqni-ee ru-usihim*): some say it means “to run away” or “scamper with raised head” i.e. wherever the fancy takes one (in a disturbed state).

“الْقِنْوَةُ” (*al-qinwah*), “الْقُنْوَةُ” (*al-qunwah*): earning.
 “قَنَوْتَهُ” (*qanaudah*): I earned it, or acquired it or hoarded it for myself.
 “اِقْتِنَاءُ الْمَالِ” (*iqatina-ul maal*): acquire wealth and hoard it.
 “الْقَنَاةُ” (*al-qanaat*): Stick.
 “قَنَاةُ الْحَاظِ” (*qana-ul haa-it*): the shadowy part of a wall, which is away from the light. It also means a drain or a pipe from which water finds its way out {*T, R*}.
 “الْقِنْوُ” (*al-qinwu*), “الْقُنْوُ” (*al-qunwu*): bunch of dates.

The plural are “الْقِنْوَانُ” (*al-qinwaanun*), “الْقُنْوَانُ” (*al-qunwaanun*).
 “قِنْوَانُ زَانِيَةٍ” (*qinwanun zaniyah*): the hanging bunches which are hanging near (6:100).

“الْقِنْيَةُ” (*al-qinyah*), “الْقُنْيَةُ” (*al-qunyah*): earning acquired by a man. It also means accumulated wealth.
 “قَنَى الْمَالَ يَقْنِي” (*qanal-maala yaqini*): he earns money.
 “اَقْنَاهُ اللَّهُ” (*aqnaat-ullaah*): Allah gave him things after acquiring which he became peaceful and content. Those things also fulfilled his immediate requirements and he was able to save them for the future too.
 “أَرْضٌ مَقْنَاءُ” (*arzun maqnaat*): the land which becomes suitable for one who lands there, where he finds everything and thus he is happy with it.
 “اَقْنَى” (*aqna*): to make happy {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

53:48	Allah is the one who makes man independent and gives him that which keeps him happy and content.	وَأَنَّهُ هُوَ أَعْنَى وَ أَقْنَى
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“الْقَاهِرَةُ” (*al-qaahirah*): the upper part of anything, like the chest, armpit etc. It also means loftiness.
 “جِبَالٌ قَوَاهِرُ” (*jibaalun qawahir*): high mountain, overwhelming.
 “الْقَاهِرُ” (*al-qahru*): to hold on to someone from the upper part to overcome him. It also means domination, authority, overcoming, grip.
 “قَاهَرَهُ” (*qaharah*): he overcame him. It also means to make obedient.
 “لَحْمٌ مَقْهُورٌ” (*lahmun maqhoor*): meat which is kept on the fire to be roasted while juice is still dripping {*T*}.

The Quran mentions an attribute of Allah as “الْقَهَّارُ” (*qah'haar*) in (12:39). The word “جَبَّارٌ” (*jabbar*) has already been explained under the heading (*J-B-R*) which means “he who casts strongly broken bones in a cast”.
 “الْقَهَّارُ” (*al-qah'haar*) would mean “one whose law engulfs everyone”, or “someone whom nobody can defeat”, or “he whom no one can overpower”.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:18	He is dominant on his servants	وَهُوَ الْقَاهِرُ فَوْقَ عِبَادِهِ
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This attribute befits Allah because he enjoys domination over the entire universe, but when a man claims or attributes this quality to him then he is being rebellious. The Quran has related this to the statement of the Pharaoh:

7:127	And we (Pharaoh's people) are dominant over <i>Bani Israel</i>	وَأَنَّا فَوْقُهُمْ قَاهِرُونَ
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The Quran says:

93:9	Do not be harsh with somebody who becomes alone in society thinking him to be without any help or friend,	فَأَمَّا الْيَتِيمَ فَلَا تَغْهَرْ
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	(do not think him to be demeaned, and do not be harsh towards orphans).	
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It is allowed to conquer the things in the universe with a view to benefit, but it is wrong to be oppressive against fellow human beings or to think them to be lowly. It is however essential to dominate or overpower oppressive forces. Thus this trait for the group of **momineen** would be a good trait and would reflect an attribute of Allah. Note that power by itself is not evil.

No attribute of Allah is bad. Its usage determines whether it is good or evil. If force is used to oppress weaklings then the force is evil, but if the same force is used to prevent someone from oppression then it is good. Since Allah is goodness all the way, his every attribute is constructive. The same is applicable to a group of **momineen**.

Q-W-B

ق و ب

“قَابُ” (**qaab**): the distance between the middle of the bow to one end. It also means quantity.

The Quran has referred to the status of the messenger-hood and has stated:

53:9	And they were closer than the distance off two bows, or less	فَكَانَ قَابَ قَوْسَيْنِ أَوْ أَدْنَىٰ
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Before the advent of Islam, the Arabs used to take two bows when they made a firm pact. They used to align one with the other and thus used to align their “قَابُ” (**qaab**). Then they would pull the bow strings of both the bows and shoot a single arrow. This was meant to reflect that they were one soul but two bodies. One’s agreement is the other’s agreement, and hence a pact was made **{Rooh-ul-Ma’ani}**.

In a pact whatever one wishes, the other wishes too. Both vow to live in tandem. The Quran says that a messenger is so obedient to Allah and makes his life so harmonious with the laws of Allah that his relation with Allah’s laws becomes as if they are two men or friends who have made a pact like “قَابَ قَوْسَيْنِ” (**qaaba qausain**), or even closer than that. This is the reason that the strength which the truth gets at the hands of the messenger is attributed towards Allah himself.

The relation between the messenger and Allah is such. The messenger attains this stage and then to fulfil his aims prepares a group.

Thus, Allah’s program is implemented by the party which comes into being for this very purpose. They are the ones who raise the flag of the truth. They so merge themselves with Allah’s decisions that their decisions and deeds become the criteria for good and evil in the world and their archery become the archery of Allah.

These explanations show that Allah’s relationship with man is that of mutual friendliness. According to the messenger **Muhammed**, Allah is the greatest friend. It is man’s duty that he remains engaged till his death in implementing Allah’s program. This agreement with Allah is called **Iman** and to act according to it brings the proximity and grace of Allah, i.e. to be homogenous with Allah’s program.

“الْقُوتُ” (*al-qoot*): sustenance or food enough to keep a man alive {T}. The plural is “أَقْوَاتٌ” (*aqwaat*).

The Quran says about the earth:

41:10	have created the capacity to produce food in it	وَقَدْ رَفَعَهَا أَقْوَاتَهَا
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It means that God has formulated a law according to which it grows food in different seasons.

“الْمُقِيتُ” (*al-muqeet*): guard or protector, or he who provides sustenance to everybody according to his needs, or he who provides sustenance to the creatures {T}.

Ibn Faris says this word also means “protector” and “authority”.

Raghib says it means “he who guards something and provides food for it”.

The Quran says:

4:85	he who guards everything in the universe and provides food for them	وَكَانَ اللَّهُ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ مُّقِيتًا
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“الْقَوْسُ” (*al-qaus*): bow.

The Quran says “قَابَ قَوْسَيْنِ” (*qaaba qausain*) in (53:9). For its meaning see heading (*Q-W-B*).

“قَاسَ الشَّيْءَ بِغَيْرِهِ” (*qaasas shaiya bighairihi*): to assess something with the help of something {*Ibn Faris*}.

“” (*al-miqoos*): the starting place at a horse race, which is a rope tied in the shape of a bow and the horses for the race are placed behind it. When the race begins, the rope is dropped to the ground and horses are allowed to go in the race.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan says that words in which “ق” (*qaf*), “و” (*waw*) and “س” (*seen*) appear denote intensity and congregation.

“قَوْسُ” (*qaus*) includes an element of harshness, and for it’s both ends to meet indicates togetherness.

“قَوْلٌ” (*qaul*): a statement, or something said, or that thought which is still in the mind but not spoken. It also means belief, thought and opinion {T}. It has a lot of meanings, for instance, to hit, to overcome, to die, to receive comfort, to be attentive etc. {T}.

“تَقَوَّلَ عَلَيْهِ قَوْلًا” (*taqawwala alaihi qaula*): fabricate something and attribute it to someone else (69:44).

To think is called “وَيَقُولُونَ فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ” (*yaquluna fi anfusihim*) as in (58:8). The plural of “قَوْلٌ” (*qaul*) is “أَقْوَالٌ” (*aqwaal*) and its plural are “أَقَاوِيلٌ” (*aqaweel*), as in (69:44).

“قِيلَ” (*qeel*): to say, or to have a conversation, or the call of the heart, as in (43:88).

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan says that the words with “ق” (*qaf*), “و” (*waw*) and “ل” (*laam*) together have the indication of moving and to flutter.

“قَوْلٌ” (*qaul*) includes the movement of the tongue or the lips {*Ilm-ul-Akhlaaq*}. But as said earlier, this is its initial meaning. Figuratively it also may mean the belief in the heart.

This word has been used at many places in the Quran. It is difficult to mention them all, but at every place its meaning can be determined easily, so we do not need go into detail.

Q-W-M ق و م

“قَامَ” (*qaam*), “قِيَامًا” (*qiyama*): to stand or to be balanced, or for some matter to be balanced, or to be in proportion, to be solid and smooth, or to be steadfast and enduring, or to do some work always, or to stop, or to stop at some place. It also means to be feisty {T}.

“أَقَامَ” (*aqama*): corrected and straightened, or made to stand up.

“قَامَ الرَّجُلُ الْمَرْأَةَ وَقَامَ عَلَيْهَا” (*qaamur rajulul mar’ata waqaama alaiha*): the man patronized the woman, fulfilled her needs and was responsible for them, or brought her supplies.

“قَوَّامٌ” (*qawwaam*): provider of sustenance, because with sustenance the balance of the social life is maintained {T}.

The Quran says:

4:34	<i>Ar-rijal</i> are protectors of <i>an-nisa</i>	الرِّجَالُ قَوَّامُونَ عَلَى النِّسَاءِ
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According to the division of work or responsibility (between man and woman) a man is supposed to be the women’s patron and they be the fulfillers of the needs of women because women are engaged and associated with the upbringing and training of the children (4:34). For example “قَوْمَ الشَّيْءِ” (*qoumunash shaiyi*) means to smooth something out or to correct it {T}.

“قَوَّامٌ” (*qawamun*): balance or proportion. It also means goods for sustenance which are required to live. It also means enough sustenance to meet the needs of life.

“قَوَّامٌ” (*qiwaam*): the thing on which some matter hinges. It also means that thing which can support a thing as enough earning to support a man.

“قَالَ قَوَّامٌ أَهْلَ بَيْتِهِ” (*fulanun qiwamu ahli baitihi*): that man provides for his family {T}.

“قَامَةً” (*qaamat*): a man’s height, or a moderate height, or a good height {T}.

“قِيَمَةً” (*qeema*): the return for something {T}.

“قِيَمَةً” (*qeemat*): when something is replaced by another and thought to be equal to the former.

“إِسْتَقَامَ الْأَمْرَ” (*istaqaamul amr*): for some matter to become proportionate and moderate, or to have a right balance {T}.

“مُسْتَقِيمٌ” (*mustaqeem*): moderate and balanced, or having the right balance {T}.

“تَقْوِيمٌ” (*taqweem*): to correct the balance and proportion {T}.

“تَقْوِيمُ الْبُلْدَانِ” (*taqweemul buldaan*): a map. Nowadays “تَقْوِيمٌ” (*taqweem*) is used to mean a calendar, etc. {M}.

“مَقَامٌ” (*maqaam*): the place to stand {T}.

“قَيُّومٌ” (*qayyum*), and “قِيَامٌ” (*qayyaam*): to plan the matters of his creation in such a way as to provide for their birth, and to give them sustenance and to be aware of their dwellings. Hence it also means someone who oversees everything.

“قَيُّومٌ” (*qayyum*) also means someone who is always there and enduring, i.e. someone who is not dependant on anyone for his existence but without whom nothing can even be thought of coming into existence. (20:11, 2:255) {T, Lataif-ul-Lugha}.

“أَمْرٌ قَيِّمٌ” (*amrun qayyim*): balanced deed or moderate and balanced work {T}.

“خُلُقٌ قَيِّمٌ” (*khulqun qayyim*): balanced courtesy.

“دِينٌ قَيِّمٌ” (*deenun qayyim*): balanced laws which distinguish the truth from falsehood.

“كُتُبٌ قَيِّمَةٌ” (*kutubun qayimat*): the laws which clearly differentiate between the truth and falsehood.

“قَوْمٌ” (*qoum*): a group of men and women, or only men’s party {T}.

Raghib say “قِيَامٌ لِلشَّيْءِ” (*qiyaamun lish shaiyi*) means that it indicates the protection of something. Sometimes “قِيَامٌ” (*qiyaam*) points to firm and resolute intent.

“قِيَامٌ” (*qayaam*) and “قَوَّامٌ” (*qiwaam*): something with which something can stay resolute and steadfast.

“قَيُّومٌ” (*qayyum*): the overseer of everything. That which provides balance, protection, and provider of everything which are required for its existence.

“قِيَامَةٌ” (*qiyamah*) actually means for a man to stand up at once.
 “الْقِيَامَةُ” (*al-qiyamah*): for that particular moment to take place in which man stands up at once.
 “إِقَامَةُ الشَّيْءِ” (*iqamatush shaiyi*): to completely fulfil the obligations.
 “لِقَامَةٍ فِي الْمَكَانِ” (*la qamatu fil makaan*): to stay somewhere resolutely {R}.
 “مُقِيمٌ” (*muqeeem*): Someone who always lives.

The explanations show that this word basically means to maintain the balance. Therefore all words that stem from this root will have the connotation of balance, whether this be physical balance or of thought or civic balance, or psychological balance. A thing that is out of balance cannot stand up (last long).

The Quran refers to a wall in relation to some orphans:

18:77	The wall was about to fall down so he straightened it (made it <i>qaaim</i>)	جَدَارًا يُرِيدُ أَنْ يَنْقَضَ فَأَقَامَهُ
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The same surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:1-2	(before mentioning <i>qayyima</i>) <i>there is no crookedness in the book</i>	لَمْ يَجْعَلْ لَهُ عِوَجًا
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It shows that “قَيِّمٌ” (*qayyim*) can only be a thing which has no fault or blemish.

“دِينُ الْقَيِّمَةِ” (*deenul qayyimah*): the balanced way of life (98:5).

“كُتُبٌ قَيِّمَةٌ” (*kutubun qayyimah*): balanced writing (98:3).

The Quran says that it shows a way which is “أَقْوَمُ” (*aqwam*) in (17:6) i.e. the straightest and most balanced path. About man it is said that he has been created “أَحْسَنَ تَقْوِيمٍ” (*ahsani taqweem*) in (95:4) (i.e. the best proportion, or having the best proportion).

“الْقِسْطَاسِ الْمُسْتَقِيمِ” (*al-qistaasil mustaqeem*): straight scales or the right scales not tampered. i.e. not only a straight path but such that even a little addition or subtraction may impair the balance (17:35).

Surah *Al-Furqaan* says that between the ways of addition and subtraction, the moderate way has been called “كَانَ بَيْنَ ذَلِكَ قَوَامًا” (*kaana baina zaalika qawama*) in (25:67).

In surah *Al-Baqrah* “مَشَى” (*mashi*) has been used against “قَامَ” (*qaam*) in (2:20) where it means to stop, and to stay. In (16:80) “إِقَامَةً” (*iqamah*) has been used again against “ظَعْنٌ” (*za'an*).

Surah *Hoodh* uses “قَاعٌ” (*qa'im*) for uprooted or destroyed dwellings (11:100) which shows that it means inhabited and bustling.

“سَبِيلٍ مُقِيمٍ” (*sabeelin muqeeem*): busy paths (15:76).

Surah *At-Takweer* says:

81:28	For whoever among you who wishes to walk on a straight (& balanced) path	لِمَنْ شَاءَ مِنْكُمْ أَنْ يَسْتَقِيمَ
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This makes the meaning of traversing the “صِرَاطٌ مُسْتَقِيمٌ” (*siraatun mustaqeem*) or the “balanced path” in (1:5) clear.

“قِيَامَةٌ” (*qiyamah*): one of the comprehensive and composite terms of the Quran, and has many connotations.

As mentioned above, *Raghib* says that it means something that happens at once. The “قِيَامَةُ” (*qiyamah*) of a nation in this world is its renaissance which takes place due to a revolution. That is, that nation stands up suddenly, and the second life after the death is a revolutionary thing in itself. The meanings of words like “قِيَامَةُ” (*qiyamat*), “آخِرَةٌ” (*aakhirat*), “سَاعَةٌ” (*sa'aat*), “بَعْثٌ” (*bo'as*) etc. is evident at the places they appear because the context makes it clear what the word there means. That is, if it means revolution and renaissance or the establishment of the life after death.

The other meaning of “حشر” (*hashar*) refers to the congregation after death. This means that the term “قيامت” (*qiyamat*) would be used to refer to the stay in this life as well as after death.

“قوم” (*qoum*) or nation. When man began civilized life, it had to begin from family life. Thus a family (and as an extension a tribe) became a unit in which the cause for unity was descent or being from the same clan. When one group’s interests clashed with that of another’s then the groups became each other’s enemies. Thus feelings of mutual acrimony within a clan and between a clan and another were created. Thus man became disunited and divided into various groups. In today’s language this is called nationality or nationalism which has pitted nations of the world against each other and has turned the world virtually into a hell. The only addition to this whole situation is that instead of a family or clan, all those who live within the boundary of a country i.e. within a geographic boundary have been declared as a nation.

Islam based on the Quran changed this concept of division of humanity, and declared that people are members of the same brotherhood, as long as they have the same ideology of life (regardless of descent, language, or country). Those who share a different ideology are members of a different community. In Quranic language it is called the difference between *Iman* and *Kufr* and in modern day language it is termed as different ideology. Therefore, according to the Quran, there are only two nations. One is that which is in line with the Quran and follows the permanent values and the other is the one which refuse to follow the permanent values and wish follow their own desires (64:2).

Applying this criterion, Nooh was told that his own son was not one of his group because he was not one of the believers (11:46). Similarly when **Loot** was told that his wife was not from among his group because she had not accepted Iman and refused to be part of his group, this was also in line with the differentiation based on ideology. When **Ibrahim** had clearly told his father and his nation that unless they believe in Allah they could not be considered as his own, then that too was a declaration of the same principle (60:4). He had also declared that those who obey or follow him were his people (14:36).

According to this criterion, the last messenger **declared through the Quran:**

49:10	All <i>momins</i> are brothers no matter what their colour, descent, language, or geographical origin be.	إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ إِخْوَةٌ
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This is the right criterion for the formulation of a nation (and not that which we have created) according to which the Quran wants to create an international brother-hood. Today the world seems to realize that the right criterion or platform for human unity is the acceptance of one ideology. The truth is that until the world adopts the Quranic way of life there cannot be lasting peace in the world. Because only Islam as explained in the Quran has the potential to provide guidance which can help create a universal brotherhood which will rise above the man made chains and limits. This is the ultimate aim and purpose of the Quran.

The Quran has described the concept and code of life as the “صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ” (*siraati mustaqeem*) in (1:5) i.e. “straight and balanced way of life”. This points towards a great truth that before the advent of the Quran, scholars and thinkers thought that life was cyclic. When naturalists observed that the planets were round in shape they thought that nature was round (or cyclic) and did not traverse on a straight path. Thus first they thought that life was cyclic. They thought that it was turning round and round in a circle and not moving ahead. This led Pythagoras to conceive of what is akin to rebirth i.e. human soul comes back into this world but in different forms, and for the soul to get out of this cycle is deliverance, and the purpose of life is to be free of these cycles and meet the whole again. This is the Hindu philosophy too and the basis of their ideology. They think that human soul is actually a part of God and being separated from it has been entangled in the cycle of life. They believe that the purpose of life is to be free of these cycles and meet the whole again. This same concept is borrowed by the *Monasts* and this same ‘*wahdatul wajud*’ (the concept of man and God being one) concept is the basis of Sufism (mysticism) or meditation. The same ‘cycle’ is found in Christianity and Judaism. The Christians believe that every child is born with the sin of its first parent and if he believes in the atonement of Jesus then he is absolved of his sins and goes to heaven. The Jews believe that the mistake their forefathers had made (of worshipping the calf) will make them go temporarily to hell after which they will be delivered.

Note that all these philosophies believe that man will become what he at first was. That is, there is no question of development or progress for him. The purpose of life is to be ‘as you were’. Cyclic movement means to move in a circularly fashion and reach ultimately from where life began.

The Quran refuted all these ideologies and declared that life is not to go round and round in a circle like an ox tied to a mill. It is supposed to move forward and rise as well. God is leading the universe on a straight path and newer creations are coming into existence on a continuous basis.

11:57	Indeed my Sustainer is on a straight path	إِنَّ رَبِّي عَلَىٰ صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ
35:1	He increases things in his creation according to His laws	يَرْبِّدُ فِي الْخَلْقِ مَا يَشَاءُ

Man too has been created to traverse the *siratin mustaqeem* i.e. the straight path. Man has been endowed with possibilities and he has been given a vast field of opportunities to face challenges and also to create challenges. He who lives according to the permanent values, will be converting his possibilities “مشهود” (*mash-huud*) i.e. evident and will keep on going ahead in life. Thus his life’s journey will not be in a circle but on a straight and balanced path. This will elevate the level of his life and he will continue to traverse the evolutionary stages.

As the Quran points to this process by declaring:

84:20	You will definitely rise by degrees and from stage to stage	لَنَرْكَبَنَّ طَبَقًا عَنْ طَبَقٍ
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This because Allah is not only the Sustainer of the straight path, but also “ذِي الْمَعَارِجِ” (*zil ma’arij*) (70:3), i.e. “Sustainer of stages”, or “He who can take towards loftiness”. Therefore, according to the Quran the purpose of the human life is not to be ‘as you were’, but to progress and to proceed forward on a continuous basis by traversing these stages. The entire universe is following this law of evolution.

The concept of “life’s cycle “ was not only the product of ancient minds , but even today many thinkers are misled by this line of thinking. The human mind has in some cases not been enlightened by the revelation. Germany’s *Nische’s* concept of eternal recurrence is a reflection of this concept. *Hegel’s* theory of opposites is also a reflection of this thought. It says that a concept is born into this world, it grows, and when it reaches its peak, another concept takes its birth which contradicts it. The new concept replaces the old one. This process of one concept replacing another concept is continuing in the universe on a continuous basis.

Marx says that this is the case with social orders too. One economic system is created, then it reaches its peak, then it is rejected and another economic system is tried, then it too reaches its peak and another system is born and it gets replaced by another one. First it was the time of capitalism, and then in its wake came communism which has now disappeared in its original form and a modified form of the capitalism is taking shape. Whenever human intellect tried to design a system on its own (and without the revelation, it resulted in failure and created more problems). Only the light of the revelation can lead man unerringly. It leads to the straight path. The Quran neither teaches to be static nor cyclic, but it teaches only to traverse the smooth and straight path of life.

”قُوَّةٌ“ (*quwwah*): one turn of the rope. If three thin ropes are intertwined to make a strong rope then each rope will be one butt or turn of the rope. Plural is ”الْقُوَى“ (*al-qawaa*).

”حَبْلٌ قَوٍ“ (*hablun qawiyin*): a rope with different turns.

”الْقُوَّةُ“ (*al-quwwah*): power, authority. It is the opposite of weakness which may be of the body or of the intellect. Plural is ”قُوَى“ (*qiwayyin*) and ”قُوَى“ (*quwayan*).

”الْقَوِيُّ“ (*al-qawiyyun*): strong and powerful. It is one of the attributes of Allah, because He alone is the possessor of the infinite strength and all types of power (11:66).

”فَرَسٌ مَقْوٍ“ (*farsun maqwin*): strong horse {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings of this word are hardness, strength and power, but the other basic meanings are the lack of goodness or the paucity of wealth and other good things.

”الْقَوَاءُ“ (*al-qawa'u*): barren land.

”الْقَوَى“ (*al-qawa*): starvation. Actually it means to be empty.

”أَقْوَتِ الدَّارُ“ (*aqwatid daar*): the house became empty.

”الْقَوَاءُ“ (*al-qawa'u*) is a barren land which has been emptied of vegetation.

”الْقَاوِيَّةُ“ (*al-qawiyyah*): the egg shell out of which the chicken has been born.

”السَّنَةُ الْقَاوِيَّةُ“ (*sanatul qaawiyah*): a year with very little rainfall.

”أَقْوَى الرَّجُلُ“ (*aqwar rajul*): he became poor and starved. He had nothing to eat despite the fact that he is living in his own home and in his own country {*T, M*}.

The Quran says that the product of the land is ”مَتَاعًا لِلْمُقْوِينَ“ (*mata-un lilmuqween*) (56:73). He is one of those of the society who have nothing to eat. The produce of the land is for the nurturing of humanity and not for making personal properties.

Muheet says ”مُقْوِينَ“ (*muqween*) means those whose tiffin careers or lunch boxes or stomachs are bereft of food or the people who alight on land where there is nothing to eat or drink. Both mean the same, that is, the needy folk of a society. At another place they are called ”سَوَاءٌ لِلْسَّاءِلِينَ“ (*sawaa lis saaeleen*) as in (41:10), that is, land should remain open and available for all those who need it.

The Quran says:

19:12	And adhere to this Godly code strongly (Resolve firmly that you will obey it)	خُذِ الْكِتَابَ بِقُوَّةٍ
51:58	Having great power	ذُو الْقُوَّةِ الْمَتِينِ
53:5	The <i>momin</i> is (as far as humans can be) also of great strength and not weak	شَدِيدُ الْقُوَى

A nation which is weak must understand that according to the Quranic criteria a weak nation cannot be a nation of *momineen*. A nation of *momineen* will use their strength and power to organise a just and egalitarian system and not to loot and plunder the weak on this earth. When force is used to stop the oppressors then it is a virtue but when it is used to plunder the weak then it is an evil.

“الْقَيْضُ” (*al-qaiz*): the white shell of the egg.

“قَيَّضَ” (*qayyaz*): to stick to something and also overpowers it. Just like the eggshell which is dominant over the egg yolk {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

41:25	And We have made them dominant over their peers	وَقَيَّضْنَا لَهُمْ قُرَنَاءَ
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“الْقَاعُ” (*al-qaa*): smooth low land with no vicissitude. It has neither stone or pebbles nor trees. Level land without any hills or mounds.

“قَاعَةُ الدَّارِ” (*qaatud daar*): front porch of a house.

Saghaani says that this root basically means to spread at some place {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is vastness or width in a place.

The noble Quran says:

20:106	Plain land where there are no ups and downs	قَاعًا صَفْصَفًا
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The plural is “قَيْعَةٌ” (*qeeaa*) which also means the same as “قَاعٌ” (*qaa'un*).

Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:39	Like a mirage in plain (desert like) land.	كَسَرَابٍ بِقَيْعَةٍ
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“قَالَ” (*qaal*), “يَقِيلُ” (*aqeel*), “قَيْلًا” (*qaila*), “قَيْلُولَةً” (*qailulah*): to take a nap, or to rest in the afternoon whether one sleeps or not.

“الْقَيْلُ” (*al-qail*): milk which is drank in the afternoon or to drink something in the afternoon.

“الْمَقِيلُ” (*al-maqeel*): the place where resting is done as in (25:24) {*T*}.

The Quran says:

7:4	When they are having their afternoon nap or rest	أَوْهُمْ قَائِلُونَ
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“ک” (*ka*) is used to compare likeness as well as to denote purpose:

7:179	They are like animals	أُولَئِكَ كَالْأَنْعَامِ
2:198	recall it (that law) because it has given you guidance	وَأَذْكُرُوهُ كَمَا هَدَاكُمْ

- 1) These meanings are related by *Mirza Abul Fazal* with reference to *Akhfash* although it can also mean recall the way He has guided you.
- 2) Sometimes it is redundant as in *Laisa Kamitlihe Shaiy'u* (42:11).

Ka (pronoun)

“ضَرَبَكَ” (*zarabaka*): he hit you.
 “غُلَامُكَ” (*ghulamuka*): your slave.

The Quran says:

2:186	when followers ask you about Me	إِذَا سَأَلَكَ عِبَادِي عَنِّي
2:35	you and your wife reside in jannah	أُسْكُنْ أَنْتَ وَزَوْجُكَ الْجَنَّةَ

Ki (pronoun)

The Quran says:

3:41	Allah made you (<i>Maryam</i>) respectful and absolved you	إِنَّ اللَّهَ اصْطَفَىٰ كِ وَاطَّهَّرَ كِ
12:29	For his own error (or fault).	لِذُنُوبِ كِ

K-A-S

“قَدْحٌ” (*al-kaas*): a drinking cup with something to drink in it. Without anything it will be called “قَدَاحٌ” (*qadah*) not “كَاسٌ” (*kaas*) {T}.

Lataif-ul-Lugha says an empty cup will be called “زُجَاجَةٌ” (*zujaajah*) but *Raghib* says that an empty cup can also be called “كَاسٌ” (*kaas*) {R}. Also *Taj-ul-Uroos* has supported this.

37:45	A cup full of flowing water	كَاسٌ مِّنْ مَّعِينٍ
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Kanna

“كَأَنَّ” (*kanna*) is a compound of “كَ” (*ka*) and “أَنَّ” (*inna*), where the first word is for similarity and the last one for emphasis.

“كَأَنَّ” (*kanna*) is used when the similarity is very strong:

27:42	He said this is very much like that (as if it is the same)	قَالَتْ كَأَنَّهُ هُوَ
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Sometimes its “تَشْدِيدٌ” (*tashdeed*), or mark used for emphasis, is done away with, like:

10:12	As if we had never been implored	كَأَن لَّمْ يَدْعُنَا
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“كَأَيِّنْ” (*kaaayyin*): many- mostly used when there is a doubt in numbers or to indicate many (in counting numbers):

3:145	Many messengers have passed	وَكَايِّنَ مِنْ نَبِيِّ
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That is, no fixed number is available but it is not few.

K-B-B

ك ب ب

“كَبَّ” (*kabbahu*), “يَكْبُهُ” (*yakubuhu*), “كَبَّ” (*kabba*): he turned him over, face down.
 “كَبَّ لَوَجْهِهِ فَأَنْكَبَ” (*kabbahu liwajhihi fankabb*): he threw him face down so he fell facing down.
 “كَبَّكَبَ الشَّيْءُ” (*kabkabash shaiyi*): he threw that thing towards a ditch.
 “كَبَّكَبَهُ” (*kabkabahu*): overturned him and spread-eagled him.

Scholars of dictionary say that there is a connotation of being overturned in “كَبَّكَبَ” (*kabkaba*), i.e. something which is thrown tends to turn over and remain in a low place {*T, R, M*}.

Ibn Faris thinks this root means to gather.

“أَلْمُكِبُّ” (*al-mukibbu*): a man whose head is lowered so his eyes are towards the ground.
 “أَكْبَبَ الرَّجُلُ” (*akabbar-rajul*): he fell face down.
 “أَكْبَبَ الرَّجُلُ عَلَى عَمَلٍ” (*akanar rajulu ala amal*): he got busy in some work {*T, R, M*}.

The Quran says about those in hell:

26:94	They will hopelessly be thrown into it face down	فَكَبَّكَبُوا فِيهَا
27:90	They were pushed into hell face down	فَكَبَّتْ وَجُوهُهُمْ فِي النَّارِ

Surah *Al-mulk* has used it in opposite meanings:

67:22	Those who adopt a path that leads to destruction	مَنْ يَمْشِ مُكِبًّا عَلَى وَجْهِهِ
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In other words it means people with overturned heads who do not use their intellect and keep on treading the wrong path heads down. Against them are those who tread the right path and tread the balanced and straight path.

K-B-T

ك ب ت

“كَبَّتْ” (*kabt*): actually means the same as “كَبَّ” (*kabb*), i.e. “to throw face down”. Hence it means “to demean” and “to insult”, or “to send back defeated”.

Azhari says that in reality “كَبَّتْ” (*kabbat*) is the same as “كَبَّدَ” (*kabd*) which means “to make the enemy return along with all his anger” {*T*}.

Raghib says it means to force someone back demeaned and insulted.

Ibn Faris says it means to demean and to move someone from something or turn away.

The Quran says:

3:126	will demean them	أَفَيَكْبِتُهُمْ
58:5	The way those before them were demeaned, they too will be demeaned and insulted	كَبُّنَا كَمَا كَبَّتِ الَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِهِمْ

“الْكَبْدُ” (*al-kabd*), “الْكَبِيدُ” (*al-kabidu*), “الْكَبِيدُ” (*al-kabid*): heartache.
 “الْكَبَادُ” (*al-kabad*): hard labour, hardness, dune or centre of a sky. It also means moderation and solidity.

The Quran says:

90:4	We have created man with complete balance and proportion { <i>Faraa</i> }	لَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ فِي كَبَدٍ
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Some say that it means “We have created man so that he can face all kinds of difficulties and adverse situations”. It can also mean that through clashing with difficulties, he can develop his traits.

Ibn Faris says it means “strength” and “intensity” in something.

“كَبُرَ” (*kibr*) and “كُبِرَ” (*kubr*): to be big. It is the opposite of “صَغُرَ” (*sighr*) which means “small”.
 “الْكَابِرُ” (*al-kaabir*) and “الْكَبِيرُ” (*al-kabeer*): Big.
 “كَبُرَ” (*kabur*): to be big in structure or rank, etc.
 “كَبِرَ” (*kabir*): to be aged.
 “الْكَبِيرُ” (*al-kibr*): the large part of something.

The Quran says:

24:11	He among them who dealt with the larger part (took a lead) of a matter	وَالَّذِي تَوَلَّى كِبْرَهُ مِنْهُمْ
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In other words it means he who takes a larger part of responsibility on his shoulders, or the one with the bigger part of any responsibility.

“كِبْرِيَاءُ” (*kibriya'u*): government and state. In today's parlance it means “sovereignty”.

The Quran has clearly said:

45:37	Sovereignty in the universe exclusively belongs to Allah . He is Powerful and Wise	وَلَهُ الْكِبْرِيَاءُ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَهُوَ الْعَزِيزُ الْحَكِيمُ
95:8	He is the only one with the command.	أَحْكَمُ الْحَاكِمِينَ

This is also the meaning of “لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ” (*la ilaha illal-laah*), i.e. “Sovereignty exclusively belongs to Allah and no one else”.

When *Moosa* invited Pharaoh's people , they replied:

10:78	We know that you brothers (<i>Moosa</i> and <i>Haroon</i>) want to be the sovereigns of this land	تَكُونُ لَكُمْ الْكِبْرِيَاءُ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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“تَكَبَّرَ” (*takabbar*) and “اسْتَكْبَرَ” (*istakbar*): to pose as the big one, or to rebel against Allah's laws.
 “أَبَى وَاسْتَكْبَرَ” (*ana wastakbar*) or “كَبُرَ عَلَيْهِ الْأَمْرُ” (*kabura alaihil amr*): the matter was unpleasant (2:34).
 “الْكَبِيرُ” (*al-kabeer*): leader, teacher or mentor.
 “أَكْبَرَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ” (*akbaratil marah*): is said when a woman has menstruation.
 “أَكْبَرَارَ الرَّجُلِ” (*akbarar-rajulu*): when a male person hits puberty.
 “أَكْبَرْنَاهُ” (*akbarnah*): the matter was expelled (12:31)

Mujahid says that when verse (12:31) mentions the women who saw *Yusuf* it means that they started to menstruate when they saw him. However, this meaning does not make sense when studied in the context of the verse. More appropriate meaning is that when these women saw *Yusuf* they found him to be a great personality i.e. to be of strong character.

The Quran says “اِسْتَكْبَرَ” (*istakbar*) against obedience (16:49, 2:34) and against weak and old people too.

14:21	To those who were arrogant	لِّلَّذِينَ اسْتَكْبَرُوا
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“اَكْبَرُ” (*akbar*) has been used against “اَدْنَى” (*adna*) in (32:21).

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:51	(Whether you turn in to stone or iron or any other creature) that you think in your heart is difficult to create	اَوْ خَلْقًا مِّمَّا يَكْبُرُ فِي صُدُورِكُمْ
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“اَلْمُتَكَبِّرُ” (*al-mutakabbir*): the possessor of all greatness. It is an attribute of Allah as in (59:23). Since it is good to reflect the attributes of Allah in oneself, therefore it is good to be “مُتَكَبِّرُ” (*mutakabbir*) as a *momin*.

The Quran says:

3:138	you will be superior (if follow the Quran)	اَنْتُمْ اَلْاَعْلَوْنَ
7:146	Those who show arrogance (<i>takabbur</i>) in the land without any justification.	يَتَكَبَّرُونَ فِي الْاَرْضِ بِغَيْرِ الْحَقِّ

If the word is taken to mean sovereignty, then “تَكَبَّرُ” (*takabbur*) can be said only for Allah and not for a man. Thus the meaning of verse (7:146) would be that sovereignty only belongs to Allah. That is, sovereignty can only be attributed to Allah’s laws and not to man-made laws.

“كَبُرَ” (*kibr*) has the connotation of not to be subjugated. Thus it is not permitted for human beings to follow or be subservient to any other law but Allah’s.

“كُبَّارٌ” (*kubbaar*): very big (71:22).

“اَلْكُبُرُ” (*al-kubar*): very great miseries (74:35).

In surah *Al-mudassar* the messenger was told:

74:2	Rise, and make people aware about the wrong way of life they are set on	فُمْ فَأَنْذِرْ
74:3	Establish such a system or make such conditions prevail that it becomes clear that Allah’s laws, and this system is better than any other in the world	وَ رَيْكَ فَكَبِّرْ

To prevent people from traversing the wrong path was the initial part, this second part is constructive.

Every nation holds this opinion that its system is the best of all. However, the Quran invites *momineen* to implement a system which serves as a model so that everyone calls out that all greatness definitely belongs to Allah.

This has been called “وَكَبَّرَهُ تَكْبِيرًا” (*wakabbirhu takbeera*) in (17:111) and “وَلَذِكْرُ اللَّهِ أَكْبَرُ” (*wal-zikrullaahi akbar*) in (49:45).

In the call out for prayers “الله اكبر” (*allah ho akbar*) is a declaration of the fact that Allah’s system is the best in the world. This is the declaration due to which during the ten years of the Messenger’s life in *Medina*, about 275 square miles were daily added in the Islamic State. During the time of *Omar* its area had increased to 2.2 million square miles. This word “اَكْبَرُ” (*akbar*) has not been used by the Quran for Allah, but there is no doubt in Him being great. He alone is the greatest or “اَكْبَرُ” (*akbar*).

The Quranic system had overcome the Persian and Roman systems. Note how great this declaration was which today has been reduced merely to a custom.

“كَتَبَ” (*katab*): the Arabs used to sew a kind of iron lid in front of female camel’s vagina so they could be kept safe from being made pregnant from all sorts of lowly breed male camels.
This process was called “كَتَبَ النَّاقَةَ” (*kataban naaqah*). This is even done today to pure breed mares.

Ibn Faris too supports this meaning.

Similarly, the Arabs used to sew the nostrils of their female camels shut so they could not smell their young ones. This was also referred as “كَتَبَ” (*katab*) {T}.

“كَتَبَ” (*katab*) also means to close a sack by sewing its end, or to close a water bag.

“كَتَبَ” (*kitaab*): to gather separate pages and to sew them together in the shape of a book in order to preserve them together, or to pack goods together in a sack or a bag. *Ibn Faris* too has said, this is the basic meaning of this word.

This shows that when the Quran calls itself “الْكِتَابَ” (*al-kitaab*), then it means that Quran was never on scattered pages nor written on bones or leaves of date palms (as generally quoted), but was a composite book.

If it had been in a dispersed state, then it could not have been called “كِتَابٌ” (*kitaab*).

“كَتَبَ” (*katab*): came to mean “he wrote”, since scattered thoughts are written and thus kept safe,

“اِكْتَتَبَ” (*iktatab*): he wrote himself or had it written or dictated to someone (25:5). *Raghib* says it means to fabricate.

“كِتَابٌ” (*kitaab*) also means “order” or “decision” {T}.

The Quran says:

2:178	Prescribed for you is this legal retribution.	كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْقِصَاصُ
2:183	Prescribed for you is the fasting	كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الصِّيَامُ

Hence this word has appeared to mean incumbent and necessary.

In other words it means “that which is declared mandatory”. Therefore the group of laws are collectively called “كِتَابٌ” (*kitaab*) because the Quran contains different types of laws in it.

Ibn Faris and *Lataif-ul-Lugha* too has said that “الْكِتَابَ” (*al-kitaab*) means duty and order. As such when the Quran has been called “الْكِتَابَ” (*al-kitaab*), then it means “set of laws”.

Surah *An-noor* says:

24:33	Those among your followers who want to make a pact (regarding their freedom)	وَالَّذِينَ يَبْتَغُونَ الْكِتَابَ
2:235	(When the period of <i>iddat</i>) which has been fixed as per laws of Allah, reaches its maturity	حَتَّى يَبْلُغَ الْكِتَابُ أَجَلَهُ

Surah *Yunus* says:

10:69	Every nation has a fixed term	لِكُلِّ أُمَّةٍ أَجَلٌ
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Here “fixed” does not mean that such and such nation will rise till such and such period after which it will fall. It means:

13:38	for every period there is a law	لِكُلِّ أَجَلٍ كِتَابٌ
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That is, the life and death of nations (or the rise and fall of nations). The nation which so wants can increase its time period of life (or peak) while adopting the relevant law. The law (scales related to deeds and their effects) is fixed by Allah. Every nation can rise or fall according to this law.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:144	Nobody can die without being so ordained by the law of Allah	مَا كَانَ لِنَفْسٍ أَنْ تَمُوتَ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ كِتَابًا مُؤَجَّلًا
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This very law defines the period of one's life:

35:11	The increase or shortening of age takes place according to the laws of Allah	وَمَا يُعَمِّرُ مِنْ مَعْمَرٍ وَلَا يُنْقِصُ مِنْ عُمُرِهِ إِلَّا فِي كِتَابٍ
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Man has been made aware of this law. As such, whoever wants to increase his life may do so by acting on this law. Conversely if he doesn't act on this law, then his life becomes shortened. A man can die when he wants to (commit suicide or take his own life whenever he wants) and shorten it by being careless e.g. about his diet. But according to this law, when the period of one's life terminates then it can't be delayed or extended e.g. being terminally ill due to cancer (63:11).

Tafseer-ul-Minar says that "كِتَابٌ" (*kitaab*) means "مَكْتُوبٌ" (*maktoob*), and by saying "ذَلِكَ الْكِتَابُ" (*zaalikal-kitaab*) in (2:2), the Messenger was only asked to put down the Quran in writing. Thus the Quran was presented and existed in book form as pointed out in this verse.

The Quran has also mentioned "كِتَابٌ" (*kitaab*) to mean the laws of Allah. Therefore it is the book of Allah, i.e. the collection of Allah's laws in compiled and protected form.

The basic point of the Quran is the Law of requital and it explains this process in detail covering its various aspects. In other words, no thought and act of man can be without result. This point has been explained in the Quran (45:22). Surah *Al-infitaar* says:

82:10	Such forces hover over you (sent by Allah)	وَأِنَّ عَلَيْكُمْ لَحَافِظِينَ كِرَامًا كَاتِبِينَ يَعْلَمُونَ مَا تَفْعَلُونَ
82:11	Which are watching over you.	
82:12	They are respected writers who know whatever you do.	تَفْعَلُونَ

"كِرَامًا كَاتِبِينَ" (*kiraaman katibeena*) has been explained by "يَعْلَمُونَ مَا تَفْعَلُونَ" (*ya lamuna ma tafaloon*) i.e. "those who are aware of your deeds".

In these meanings this word "كِتَابٌ" (*katab*) has also appeared at other places.

In surah *At-toor* "يَكْتُبُونَ" (*yaktaboon*) means "to know".

In surah *Al-ambia* "وَأَنَّا لَهُ كَاتِبُونَ" (*kaatiboon*) means "those who keep score" (21:94)

In surah *An-namal* "كِتَابٌ" (*kitaab*) has been used to mean a letter (27:28). This is the letter which has been mentioned in (27:40).

The Quran has used "كِتَابٌ" (*kitaabun*) and "حِكْمَةٌ" (*hikmatun*), and both have been called "منزل من الله" (*manzil minal-laah*). See heading hah, (*H-K-M*)

"كِتَابٌ" (*kitabun*): law.

"حِكْمَةٌ" (*hikmat*): the purpose of a law.

That is why it has been said:

2:183	fasting has been prescribed for you	كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الصِّيَامُ
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Here "كِتَابٌ" (*kitab*) means "law". The purpose of this law has been described as "حِكْمَةٌ" (*hikmat*):

2:183	so that you may develop <i>taqwa</i>	لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَّقُونَ
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Hence the purpose of this law of fasting is that you can be a *muttaqi* (e.g. defined in 2:177).

The Quran while laying down laws has stated their purpose too so that we can judge for ourselves whether that purpose of the law is being fulfilled or not. If the result of our actions is manifesting as mentioned by the Quran, then the law is being acted upon correctly. But if the declared results are not being created then the law is being fulfilled only in ritual form. This is a very big reality which the Quran has invited us to use as a criterion to judge our actions. The prayers and fasting as part of worship across the world by those who claim to be the followers of the Quran are not producing the desired results as noted in the Quran. Therefore the conclusion is that the Quran is not being followed as directed by Allah and explained in the book. From the Quranic perspective this life and the next life are one life. However, in this life each one of us is accountable for what we do and the effects of this conduct influence our character building. This is part of the self-development process to which the Quran has referred frequently. The Quran has clearly sign posted the righteous path and its benefits and it is up to us to use this criterion and achieve its benefits here as well as in the hereafter. If the results of our deeds are not being produced as the Quran says, then there is something wrong with our deeds, and we should remember that these will also fail to produce the desired results in the hereafter.

“كِتَابٌ” (*kitabun*) and “حِكْمَةٌ” (*hikmatun*) or the law and their results are the basic points of *Deen*, i.e. acting according to the Quranic dictum which will produce happy results in this world as well as in the hereafter. Therefore while it is necessary to keep in mind what the Quranic law says in some matter that we should also keep in mind its declared result so that we can judge for ourselves if we have acted correctly. In the absence of the external guidance of the Quran as a criterion we cannot judge our thoughts and deeds as we do not have any internal guidance. If the Quranic permanent values are not in our memory or if we do not refer to them on a regular basis through our own desire (freedom to choose), then we cannot regulate our thoughts and deeds and as a consequence we cannot get the desired effects.

K-T-M

ک ت م

“كَتَمَ” (*katm*): to hide.

“رَجُلٌ كَتُومٌ” (*rajulun katum*): a man who hides secrets.

“سِرِّكَاتِم” (*sirrun katim*): a secret {T}.

The Quran has used “كَتَمَ” (*katm*) against “إِبْدَاءٌ” (*ibdaa'un*) which means “to come forth”. It has also come against “إِخْرَاجٌ” (*ikhraaj*) which means to oust (2:73), and also against “بَيِّنٌ” (*bayyan*) which means “to make evident” (2:159, 3:186), and also against “جَهْرٌ” (*jahrun*) in (21:110). These make the meanings of “كَتَمَ” (*katm*) clear.

Lataif-ul-Lugha says that “كَتَمَ” (*katm*) means “to keep the meaning hidden” and “سَتَرَ” (*satar*) means “to hide materialistic things”.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:70	Why do you mix truth with falsehood and hide the truth?	لَمْ تَلْبِسُوا الْحَقَّ بِالْبَاطِلِ وَتَكْتُمُونَ الْحَقَّ
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This means as per the Quran both mixing these two and hiding the truth are crimes. Truth should always be unadulterated and must be manifested as it is. The truth in the Quran is unadulterated. The Quran is unadulterated truth. Therefore the Quran should never be mixed with anything else if we wish draw its benefits, and must be proclaimed clearly and truthfully.

“الْكُتْبُ” (*al-kasb*): to gather something and make a heap out of it, or to spill water, etc. from a height.
 “إِنْكَتَبَ الرَّمْلُ” (*inkasabar ramal*): sand got collected {*M*}.
 “الْكَيْتَبُ” (*al-kaseeb*): sand dune.
 “الْكَبَاءُ” (*al-kas ba'u*): earth {*T*}.

The Quran says that at the time of the great revolution, the leaders of a nation, which are referred to as “جِبَالٌ” (*jibaal*), will become “كَيْتَباً مَهِيلاً” (*kaseeban maheela*). This means that they will become like sand dunes which will leave their places from the bottom and come down as sand dunes do (73:14).
 “اَكْتَبَ الصَّيْدُ” (*aksabas sayd*): the prey came within the reach of the hunter {*R, F*}.

“كَثْرَةٌ” (*kasrah*): profusion, abundance, to be much. It is the opposite of shortage or “قِلَّةٌ” (*qillat*).
 “اَكْتَرَّ الرَّجُلُ” (*aksarar rajul*): the man became very wealthy.
 “اِسْتَكْتَرَّ مِنَ الشَّيْءِ” (*istaksara inash shaiyi*): to be inclined towards taking more out of something {*T*}.

The Quran says:

74:6	Do not be kind to someone with the intent of taking more in return than you give.	وَلَا تَكُنْ نَسَكِيْرًا
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“اَلْكَوْثَرُ” (*al-kausar*): anything that is abundant and good.

Maulana Abeerullah Sindhi writes in his book *Al-maqaam Al-mahmood* that “اَلْكَوْثَرُ” (*al-kausar*) means the Quran itself because its guidance has been termed by God himself as abundant goodness and the Quran is an embodiment of goodness.

When the Messenger and his followers were being prosecuted in every way and things were very difficult, so much so that the Messenger's migration to another land seemed probable, then the Messenger was told to be forbearing because the initial stage of the establishment of Allah's system was coming to an end. After some time the results of the struggle began manifesting.

108:1	We have granted your with <i>al-kausar</i>	اِنَّا اَعْطَيْنَاكَ الْكَوْثَرَ
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After the migration (to *Medina*) this statement turned into a reality.

It is also thought that in the *Hebrew* language the word *kosher* means permissible. The animals which the Jews slaughter for consumption is still called *kosher*, and that “كَوْثَرٌ” (*kausar*) is the Arabic form of this word. Accordingly the verse (108:1) would mean “We gave you camel in permissible form. For the explanation of this see heading (*N-He-R*). But I think that the meaning of abundant goodness is more suitable.

“كَثُرَ” (*kasur*): to be abundant (4:7).
 “كَثَّرَ” (*kassar*): to increase, or to make more (7:86).
 “اَكْتَرَّ” (*aksar*): to increase (11:32).
 “تَكَاثَرُوا” (*takasar*): to compete with each other in wealth (102:1).
 “اِسْتَكْتَرَّ” (*istaksar*): to acquire too much (7:188) or to benefit a lot (2:129).

The Quran says:

102:1	To compete with a view to acquire more than each other makes you oblivious of the real purpose of life	اَلْهٰكُمُ التَّكَاثُرُ
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According to the Quran, wealth is the adornment of life (7:32). Therefore to intend to acquire it is not bad, but to consider the acquisition of wealth as the sole purpose of life so that one can have more than others, is a low mentality (57:20). The Quran says that this lust for wealth can never end and at any stage,

no matter how wealthy a man becomes. All his life man becomes engaged in this acquisition and he loses the true purpose of life which is self-development within the domain of the permanent values.

102:2	Till he reaches the grave	حَتَّىٰ رُزِّمَ الْمَقَابِرَ
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The Quran says that competition is not bad but it should be in a different field. Competition must be in developing one's personality and to excel in righteous deeds which result in *jannat* (83:26). Wealth is a means of attaining something for fulfilling some purpose, not an end in itself. So much so, that a man's entire life is also a means to achieve a lofty ideal, and not an end in itself. To consider wealth or pleasures of physical life, as the purpose of life is a big mistake. The objective should be to develop the human personality which can be only be achieved through working within the permanent values for the good of mankind on universal basis. Wealth should remain a means towards that end and that's it.

K-D-H ك د ح

“الْكَدْحُ” (*al-kadh*): strife and struggle. Persistent struggle and continuous effort.

“كَدَحَ رَأْسَهُ بِالْمَشْطِ” (*kadaha raasahu bilmusht*): he combed his hair with a comb.

“كَدَحَ لِإِيَالِهِ” (*kadaha li iyaalihi*): he earned for his family with great effort {*T, R, F*}. It has an element of strife which is back breaking.

“بِهِ كَدْحٌ” (*bihi kadh*): the wound is rather deep {*T, R, F*}.

The Quran says:

84:6	O mankind, indeed you are laboring to your Sustainer with exertion and you will meet Him	يَا أَيُّهَا الْإِنْسَانُ إِنَّكَ كَادِحٌ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ كَدْحًا فَمُلَاقِيهِ
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After this it is said that he who will be handed the list of his deeds in the right hand, will return happily to his companions, but who will be given his list of deeds from behind his back, will wish he was dead (that is, it will be so bad).

This verse can be interpreted in two ways.

- **Taj** and **Muheet** say that “كَدَحَ لِنَفْسِهِ” (*kadaha linafsihi*) means “he performed good or bad deeds for himself”. This verse would in fact mean that whether a man does good deeds or bad, their results are bound to be manifested. To meet the Sustainer means “to face the consequences as per the law of requital”.
- But if this verse is translated to mean “O man, you will have to bear rigors in order to go towards your Sustainer”, then this would mean that man will ultimately have to reach his destination that has been fixed by his Sustainer. But for this he will have to struggle hard. If he obeys the Revelation then he will face strong opposition and may even be persecuted by the opponents, but this is the easier path in terms of quicker results. However, if he does not follow the path of the Revelation, then he will struggle towards the destination through a process of trial and error over a period of centuries. His self-interests will pull him towards the past while demands of the time would ask him move forward.

Human history is a living proof of this phenomenon. Mankind is gradually moving to this destination but since has adopted the path of intellect without the light of the revelation it has to meet different travails on the way. Note how much mutual fights and blood shedding is resulting in the absence of the guidance of the revelation and this only leads to few steps forward. If he had adopted the way shown by the revelation then his life's journey would have been much easier and the life on this spaceship called Earth would have been extremely pleasant as noted in the Quran.

“الْكُدْرَةُ مِنَ الْاَلْوَانِ” (*al-kudrahatu minal-alewaan*): murkiness, or for a colour to be unclear.

Some say that “كُدْرَةٌ” (*kudrah*) is used specifically with reference to colour and “كُدُورَةٌ” (*kudurah*) is used for water and springs, while “كَدَرٌ” (*kadarun*) can be used for everything.

“كَدِرٌ” (*kidrun*), “كَدِيرٌ” (*kadeer*): anything which is murky or dirty and which is not clean.

“الْكُدْرَةُ مِنَ الْخَوْضِ” (*al-kadaratul minal-hauz*): dirt which settles at the bottom of a pool or algae which is on its surface.

“الْكُدْرَةُ” (*al-kadarah*): a big piece of earth or a big stone which has been uprooted from its ground.

“إِنْكَدَرَ” (*inkadar*): plunged speedily downwards.

“الْإِنْكَدَارُ” (*al-inkidaar*): The change which is caused by something which scatters {R}.

“” (*inkadara ilaihil qoum*): the nation attacked him in groups {T}.

“إِنْكَدَرَ عَلَيْهِ الْقَوْمُ” (*inkadar*) also means fast wind.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are murkiness, i.e. the opposite of cleanliness, and movement.

The Quran says:

81:2	when the stars become dull, or when they scatter	وَإِذَا النُّجُومُ انْكَدَرَتْ
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Figuratively it would mean “when the small states will scatter or disappear”.

This because if “الْقَمَرُ” (*al-qamar*) is taken to mean the Arabian state and “الشَّمْسُ” (*as-shams*) to mean the Persian state (see headings *(Sh-M-S)* and *(Q-M-R)*), then “النُّجُومُ” (*an-nujum*) would mean “satellite states”. In the existing world this may mean changes in the world relating to the powerful nations under the capitalist system. If it means changes in the universe related to stars then the literal meanings of this verse would apply.

“الْكُدْيَةُ” (*al-kudyah*): hard land, or very hard rock.

“أَكْدَى الرَّجُلُ” (*akdar rajul*): he was miserly.

“أَكْدَى الْحَافِرُ” (*akdal-haafir*): the digger met hard land or hard rock and stopped digging further.

“أَكْدَى الْمَطَرُ” (*akdal-matar*): the raining decreased {T, M}.

The Quran says:

53:34	He gives a little then turns hard, like a rock {F}	أَعْطَى قَلِيلًا وَ أَكْدَى
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A *momin* keeps for him only that which is necessary to meet his needs and makes everything else available for the needs of others. Someone who is with the group of *momineen* without having heartfelt belief in their system and stays with the group only due to some expedience, always tries to find inroads (53:33). In other words, he gives little and then desisting and making excuses.

“الْكَذِبُ” (*al-kazab*): to knowingly give wrong news or information. But some say that this very word will be used whether wrong news is delivered deliberately or not {T}.

“أَكْذَبَ الرَّجُلُ” (*akzabar rajul*) is said when a man is called out and he pretends to be asleep.

“كَذَبَةٌ” (*kazzaban*): the cloth which is printed or coloured in different colours {Aqrib-ul-Muwarid}.

“كَذَّبَ فِي سَيْرِهِ” (*bazaba fi sairih*): the camel became slow, i.e. did not maintain the speed it could, or adopted a bad stance {T}.

“كَذَّبَ” (*kazaba*): sometimes mean “to be compulsory” {T}.

The Quran has said in surah *Al-munafiqoon* that “O Messenger, when these hypocrites come to you, they say that they are witness to the fact that you are the messenger of Allah. Then, although Allah knows that you are His messenger”:

63:1	Indeed, these hypocrites are liars	إِنَّ الْمُنَافِقِينَ كَذِبُونَ
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Here the meaning of “كَذِبٌ” (*kazib*) becomes clear, i.e. although something may well be true as per the evidence, but if the heart does not support the tongue, then it is “كَذِبٌ” (*kazib*). But if the heart and tongue are one about something even if the matter is not as it appears then it will not be called “كَذِبٌ” (*kazib*). It will be taken as beyond his knowledge. That is, he is not aware of the right thing (and not lying): The Quran has warned not to pursue something about which we are unaware (17:36). Therefore only that which is known for certain must be spoken.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:18	fake blood	يَدِّمُ كَذِبٍ
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“كَاذِبٌ” (*kaazib*): liar (11:93).
 “كَذَّابٌ” (*kazzab*): a very big liar (40:28).
 “مَكْذُوبٌ” (*makzooob*): the lie (11:65).
 “كَذَّبَ” (*kazzab*): denied (23:25).
 “تَكْذِيبٌ” (*takzeeb*): to deny (85:19).
 “مُكَذِّبٌ” (*mukazzib*): he who continues to deny and never accepts (56:51).

The revelation i.e the Quran presents all its values based on knowledge and evidence and supports it with logic and reasoning. It also calls upon its opponents to present reasoning and evidence if their counter claims are valid (2:112). This is the right way to arrive at the truth. But if someone has predecided that something is to be denied at all costs then the truth can never be reached. This “تَكْذِيبٌ” (*takzeeb*) or denial has been declared by the Quran to be a serious crime against oneself and others. “تَكْذِيبٌ” (*takzeeb*) also means that one’s deeds are not compatible with the beliefs.

Surah *Al-ma’oon* clarifies this reality:

107:1	Have you seen the one who denies this Deen (through deeds)?	أَرَأَيْتَ الَّذِي يُكَذِّبُ بِالْذِّينِ
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After this it is said that this is such a person who pushes away orphans and does not instigate feeding poor. These are the so called devotees who are oblivious of the real purpose of *Deen*. They only consider the genuflection as their *Deen* and block the sources of sustenance which should be kept open for all (107:2-7). So now we can well understand as to who commit “تَكْذِيبُ دِينٍ” (*takzeeb ad-deen*) or denial of this *Deen* or way of life)

K-R-B

ك ر ب

“الْكَرْبُ” (*al-karb*) denotes severe sadness.
 “كَرْبُ الْأَرْضِ” (*karb-ul-ard*): to cultivate land.
 “كَرَبَتِ الشَّمْسُ” (*karibatish-shams*): sun neared its set.
 “الْكَرْبُ” (*al-karb*) also means to wind a rope, as well as to tighten the chains on a prisoner. It also means the rope which is tied to a bucket of a well, and as it is dipped in water. Every time the bucket is used to extract water from the well, it petrifies quickly.
 “كَرَبَ النَّاقَةَ” (*karaban naaqah*): he loaded a camel.
 “الْكَرْبُ” (*al-kareeb*): land which has never been cultivated {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is intensity and strength.

These meanings make the meaning of “الْكَرْبُ” (*al-karb*) clear. That is, severe sadness in which a man is engulfed. He becomes hopeless, and his heart is burdened. There is only one way to get rid of this “كَرْبٌ” (*karb*) and that is by obeying the laws of Allah.

6:64	Say: It is Allah Who delivers you from these and all other distresses..	قُلِ اللَّهُ يُخْرِجُكُم مِّنْهَا وَمِنْ كُلِّ كَرْبٍ
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Also see (21:76).

“الْكُرْبِيُّونَ” (*al-karbiyyun*): angels those are close to God {*M*}. This is Arabic form of the Hebrew word *karubeam*. The Quran has not used this word.

K-R-R ك ر ر

“الْكُرُّ” (*al-karr*): to return something, or bend it, or make it turn back.

“كَرٌّ” (*karr*): a thick rope {*M*}.

“التَّكْرِيرُ” (*at-takrrer*): to reiterate, or to repeat.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to gather and to turn back, or not to say a thing more than three times and repeat, or to stress a thing. But in repetition these two things are not necessary {*T*}.

The Quran reiterates this wish of the unbelievers at several places:

2:167	If once we can go back to life then we will do this and that.	لَوْ أَنَّ لَنَا كَرَّةً
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But this has been refuted (39:58-59) because life is like a flowing spring. The water that flows ahead can never turn back. Similarly, nobody can return to this world stage. To return to this world as per the concept of reincarnation is against the teachings of the Quran. The law of evolution does not brook reiteration or repetition. Either one must move ahead (to *jannat*) or be static (in *jahannam*).

The Quran says:

79:12	This coming alive after dying will be very harmful	تِلْكَ إِذَا كَرَّةٌ خَاسِرَةٌ
17:6	Then we made the events be according to your liking and against your enemies	ثُمَّ رَدَدْنَا لَكُمُ الْكَرَّةَ عَلَيْهِمْ

K-R-S ك ر س

“الْكُرْسُ” (*al-kirs*): basis {*T, M, R*}.

“الْكُرْسِيُّ” (*al-kursiyyu*): chair which is used to sit on.

“الْكُرْسِيُّ” (*al-kursiyyu*), “الْكُرْسِيُّ” (*al-kursi*): governance and power, or knowledge. The scroll which contains knowledge is called “كُرَّاسَةٌ” (*kurraasa*). Some say that “كُرَّاسَةٌ” (*kurraasa*) means pages which have been bound together.

“التَّكْرِيسُ” (*at-takrees*): to join the part of anything with another part {*T, M, R*}. Nowadays this word is used to mean “copy”.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this word is to accumulate one over another.

The Quran says:

2:255	Allah’s ‘ <i>kursi</i> ’ or authority encompasses the entire universe	وَسِعَ كُرْسِيُّهُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ
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Here according to the dictionary and according to *Al-Manar* too, it means the knowledge of Allah, although it may also mean authority. “Knowledge” seems more befitting because earlier it has been said:

2:255	They cannot comprehend anything which is in His knowledge excepting that which he wills.	وَلَا يُحِيطُونَ بِشَيْءٍ مِنْ عِلْمِهِ إِلَّا بِمَا شَاءَ
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Surah *Saad* uses this word to mean the government of *Suleman* (38:34). There too “كُرْسِيُّهُ” (*kursiyyuhi*) does not mean “seat” but “authority” or “power”; all signify authority.

“الْكَرَمُ” (*al-karam*) is a trait opposite to meanness. Since meanness was considered the worst trait among Arabs, “كَرَمٌ” (*karam*) was the best trait. It actually means to bear the burden of protecting a nation, or to spend for the collective benefit of a nation or strive for it.

“كَرَمٌ” (*karam*): provide benefit without any consideration of personal gain. It also means sincerity. “الْإِكْرَامُ” (*al-ikraamu*) and “التَّكْرِيمُ” (*al-takreem*): to provide benefit to someone in which there is no shame for anyone for being in need of help, and the benefit that is provided is also noble {T}.

“الْكَرِيمُ” (*al-kareem*) is a composite term among the Arabs which encompasses all sorts of goodness. It is used for a person who has not even an inkling of bad trait. It also means free and gentle, philanthropic, or he who keeps himself safe from violating the injunctions of the Quran. It also means a person who is soft spoken, kind, broad minded, possessor of good traits and respectful. It also means a horse on which battle is fought, or a camel on which water is laden and fetched. It also means every likeable and selected thing {T}. Abundant rain is also called “كَرِيمٌ” (*kareem*).

“أَرْضٌ مَكْرَمَةٌ” (*ardun makramah*): land which is prepared well for cultivation after manure, etc. It also means a good land which can give good crop. “كَرُمَتْ أَرْضُهُ الْعَامَ” (*karumat arduhul aam*): a good crop was produced this year due to the use of fertilizer. “كَرَّمَ السَّحَابُ تَكْرِيماً” (*karramas sahaabu takreema*): the cloud rained very well {T}. No one can be called “كَرِيمٌ” (*kareem*) until he has not shown “كَرَمٌ” (*karam*) {R}.

The Quran says about the shade of *jahannam*:

56:44	There is no coolness in it, or pleasantness, or benefit of any kind.	لَا بَارِدٍ وَلَا كَرِيمٌ
25:72	when they face some meaningless and non-sensible matter they pass by it in a very decent way	إِذْ أَمَرُوا بِاللَّعُونِ مَا كَرَاماً

Surah *Al-Alq* calls Allah as “الْأَكْرَمُ” (*al-akram*) in (96:3).

This has also been called “ذُو الْجَلَالِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ” (*zul jalaali wal-ikraam*) in (55:27).

“كَرَّمَ” (*karrama*) and “أَكْرَمَ” (*akram*): to bestow respect (17:62, 89:15).

“تَكْرِيماً” (*takreem*) has come against “أَبَانَ” (*ahaann*) in (89:16).

“عِبَادٌ مُكْرَمُونَ” (*i'badun mukramoon*): respected followers (21:26).

“مُكْرِمٌ” (*mukrim*): one who bestows respect (22:18).

“رِزْقٌ كَرِيمٌ” (*rizqun kareem*): respectable sustenance (8:4). This is one of the particularities of a *jannati* society that respectful sustenance will be available there. That is, the accoutrements of life in abundance and with respect too. A nation which gets such sustenance is indeed lucky, but this can only be had by living according to the permanent values outlined by the Quran (in this world as well as in the hereafter).

The Quran says:

17:70	We have made all <i>Bani Adam</i> (human race) as <i>kareem</i> or respectful and good	وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ
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The Quran was the first to declare man's respectability, i.e. every human being is respectful by virtue of possessing a free will. This fundamental right to respect man was first given by the Quran. After this a man gains respect as he moves along in life.

49:13	He who safeguards them most (that is observes the laws the most) becomes the most respectable	إِنَّ أَكْرَمَكُمْ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ أَتَقْوَمُ
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Note how the Quran replaced the old criteria of respect such as gender, family, status, caste, wealth, ancestry, nationality, etc. and gave new criterion for respect according to which every man simply by virtue of being human is respectful. In other words instead of additional traits, personal traits are considered the criteria for earning additional respect. This criterion alone takes away all the so-called respect of royalty or monasticism, and all old systems of hierarchy. Every human child whether he is born in a king's palace or in a beggar's hut deserves equal respect simply for being a human. In order to

be more respectable for deciding the position of responsibility within a society his personal traits and deeds will count.

K-R-He ک ر ه

“الْكُرْه” (*al-karh*) or “الْكُرْه” (*al-kurh*): extreme dislike. It also means hard and disliked work.

Some scholars say that something which is unpleasant to you but you force yourself to do is called “كُرْه” (*kurh*) and for something for which someone else forces you to do is “كَرْه” (*karh*).

Raghib says that the pain which is inflicted from external sources is “كَرْه” (*karh*) and that which is self-inflicted is “كُرْه” (*kurh*).

Ibn Faris says “كُرْه” (*kurh*) is hard labour and “كَرْه” (*karh*) is something which you are forced to do unwillingly.

The Quran has used “كَرَّهًا” (*karhan*) against “طَوْعًا” (*tu'an*) in (3:82).

“طَوْعًا” (*tu'an*): willingly

“كَرَّهًا” (*karhan*): forcibly.

The Quran says:

2:216	To do battle has been made compulsory for you by law although it is unpleasant for you	كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْقِتَالُ وَهُوَ كُرْهٌ لَّكُمْ
46:15	His mother spends her days of pregnancy with great difficulty and her childbirth was also very painful	حَمَلَتْهُ أُمُّهُ كُرْهًا وَوَضَعَتْهُ كُرْهًا

Surah *An-namal* uses “إِكْرَاهًا” (*ikrah*) to mean forcibly. That is, which is done unwillingly (16:106).

In surah *Al-baqrah*, “كَرْهًا” (*kariha*) has come opposite to “أَحَبَّ” (*ahabba*) (2:216).

Similarly in (47:6) “كَرَّهًا” (*karrah*) has been used against “حُبَّ” (*hubbaba*).

“كَارِهُونَ” (*karihoon*): those who dislike (11:28).

“مَكْرُوهًا” (*makruhun*): unpleasant.

The party with whose assistance the Quran wishes to bring the revolution, accepts this system with gladness and not forcibly. Therefore it says:

2:256	One can only become a member of this society willingly and not forcibly	لَا إِكْرَاهَ فِي الدِّينِ
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The messenger was told:

10:99	Do you want to force people to believe?	أَفَأَنْتَ تُكْرِهُ النَّاسَ حَتَّى يَكُونُوا مُؤْمِنِينَ
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The forced acceptance of a belief can be physical as well as mental. For example, if we threaten with a gun and make him accept something. But it can also be mental, like when we show someone a magical trick and make him believe in something.

The third type of “إِكْرَاهًا” (*ikraah*) or coercion is to implant the age old customs of society and the practices of our ancestors in our minds even if they are not supported by the Quran, or regardless of the fact that they meet the criteria of our intellect and reasoning. This is the most severe form of coercion. What can be more severe than the coercion of the wrong sort of education and upbringing? The Quran does not permit any sort of coercion or “إِكْرَاهًا” (*ikraah*) for including one in the party of Allah’s system. It presents everything backed by reasoning and makes one agree to it with complete agreement of mind and heart, and conversely if there is no coercion to make one enter this party then there should be no coercion for leaving the party too. If the exit is closed then it would mean that you force people to stay within this party. As such, the belief that the punishment for someone who leaves *Islam* is death is against the Quran. The Quran says that nobody should forcibly be made a *muslim* nor should anyone be forced to remain a *muslim* if his heart is not happy at remaining so.

Surah *An-nahal* says:

16:106	He who turns against Islam after once accepting it incurs the wrath of Allah and severe punishment. But it does not include a person whose heart is agreeable to Islam but he is forced to denial, at least by word of mouth or acts.	مَنْ كَفَرَ بِاللَّهِ مِنْ بَعْدِ إِيمَانِهِ إِلَّا مَنْ أَكْرَهَ وَقَلْبُهُ مُطْمَئِنٌّ بِالْإِيمَانِ - وَلَكِنْ مَنْ شَرَحَ بِالْكُفْرِ صَدْرًا فَعَلَيْهِمْ عَذَابٌ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَهُمْ عَذَابٌ عَظِيمٌ
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“**kufur**” (*kufur*) is denial when it is adopted with full willingness. Thus coercion can neither make one accept or give up **Islam**. A **momin** is one who accepts all that the Quran says with all his heart and willingly stays adhered to this ideology. Even with a little coercion one’s trust becomes questionable. So much so that the Quran even refuses to accept those as **momins** who accepted **Islam** by seeing the grandeur of the **Islamic** state during the time of the Messenger **Muhammed**.

The Quran says they had become subservient to the **Islamic** state rather than having accepted **Islam** because their hearts were bereft of belief (49:14). **Momins** are those who do not fall like blind and deaf upon the verses of the Quran, not to mention other beliefs like customs, etc. They accept them only with full conviction.

25:73	Do not fall upon them deaf and blind	لَمْ يَرْوُوا عَلَيْهَا صُمًّا وَ عُمِيًّا
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Here it must be understood that nobody can forcibly be made to accept **Islam**. But this does not mean that if somebody has willingly entered **Islam**, he cannot be forced to follow the rules of the system. Till he is member of this system, he will have to follow its rules and regulations. If he does not want to follow the rules and the regulations then he must quit this system, but it can’t be that a person can remain a member of the system and accept only those principles which suit him and reject those which don’t.

K-S-B

ک س ب

“**کَسَبَ**” (*kasb*): basically means “to collect”. Later it started to also mean “to earn”, as well as “to acquire something” {T}.

2:79	The profession they had adopted (i.e. Making changes in Deen) will lead to their destruction	وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ بِمَا يَكْسِبُونَ
2:81	he who created unevenness	مَنْ كَسَبَ سَيِّئَةً

Here “**کَسَبَ**” (*kasab*) means “to create”. This verse verbally means “he who gathered unevenness for himself”.

The Quran says:

2:286	For him what he earned, and against him what he earned	لَهَا مَا كَسَبَتْ وَعَلَيْهَا مَا اكْتَسَبَتْ
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Ordinarily it is taken to mean that the benefits of good deeds are for him who has done them, and the harm done by bad deeds is for him who has done them.

But good deeds have been called “**کَسَبَ**” (*kasab*) and bad deeds “**اِکْتَسَبَ**” (*iktasab*).

Raghib says that “**کَسَبَ**” (*kasab*) means to do something that is done for one’s own benefit as well as for the benefit of others, and “**اِکْتَسَبَ**” (*iktisaab*) means work which is undertaken only for the benefit of one’s ownself. According to **Raghib**, verse (2:286) would mean that beneficial work is only that which is done for the good of self as well as for the benefit of others. But deeds in which only self-interests are intended do not develop one’s personality.

This is according to the Quranic teachings which says, ‘..what is good for mankind remains on earth..’ (13:17):

Lataif-ul-Lugha says that “كَسَبَ” (*kasab*) means good and “اِكْتَسَبَ” (*iktasab*) is used to mean evil. But what **Raghib** and **Lataif-ul-Lugha** say is not a rule. The Quran has used “كَسَبَ” (*kasab*) and “اِكْتَسَبَ” (*iktisaab*) in opposite of these meanings too.

K-S-D

ک س د

Ibn Faris says “كَسَدَ” (*kasad*) means for something to be so bad that nobody is inclined to it.

“كَسَادٌ” (*kasaad*): to go astray. Later it started to mean slackness in the market, or for some goods to be little in demand.

“كَسَدَ الْمَتَاعُ” (*kasadul mata'u*): the item is not moving in the market.

“كَسَدَتِ السُّوقُ” (*kasadatis sooq*): the market was cold.

“الْكَسِيدُ” (*al-kaseed*): cheap, or of lower quality {T, M}.

The Quran says:

9:24	That business whose loss scares you	وَبِجَارَةٍ تَخْشَوْنَ كَسَادَهَا
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K-S-F

ک س ف

“اَلْكَسْفَةُ” (*al-kisfah*): piece of something. Plurals are “كَسَفٌ” (*kisaf*) and “كَسْفٌ” (*kisfu'on*) as in (30:48) and (17:62).

Ibn Faris says it basically means for something to develop a fault which is disliked. It also means to cut one thing off from another and to separate it.

Surah **At-toor** says:

52:44	If they were to see a portion from the sky ...	اِنْ يَرَوْا كِسْفًا مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ
26:187	uncalled for sudden destruction	فَاسْتَقِطْ عَلَيْنَا كِسْفًا مِّنَ السَّمَاءِ

“كَسَفَ الثَّوَابُ” (*kasafas saub*): he cut some cloth.

“كَسَفَتِ الشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ” (*kasafatish shamsu wal-qamar*): the sun and the moon went into eclipse.

“كَسَفَتْ حَالَهُ” (*kasafat haaluhu*): his condition became bad.

“رَجُلٌ كَاسِفٌ الْبَالِ” (*rajulun kaasiful baal*): a man in bad condition.

“يَوْمٌ كَاسِفٌ” (*yaumun kaasif*): a day of extreme pain or the day the sky is torn asunder {T, R}.

K-S-L

ک س ل

“اَلْكَسَلُ” (*al-kasal*): to show laziness in something in which it must not be shown.

“اَلْكَسَالُ” (*al-kisak*): the bow and string for separating cotton from the bow {T, M}. Obviously both are present but due to them being separated, cotton can't be separated. Both are thus useless.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to express laziness in doing something and be lazy in completing it or doing it.

Keeping this meaning in mind and then note down what the Quran says about the behaviour of the hypocrites- ‘they come to salat without earnestness and that they offer contributions unwillingly’ (9:54) The Quran invites us to have a unity of thought in carrying out the righteous deeds and making sure that the desired results are produced as promised by Allah.

Also see the word “سَاهُونٌ” (*saahoon*) as in (107:5) under heading (**S-He-W**).

“الْكُسْوَةُ” (*al-kuswah*) and “الْكِسْوَةُ” (*al-kisah*): clothing which is worn {T, R}.

“رِزْقُهُنَّ” (*rizquhunna*) and “كِسْوَتُهُنَّ” (*kiswatuhunna*): their food and clothing (2:233).

“كَسَاهُ” (*kasaahu*), “كَسَوَا” (*kaswah*): made him wear the clothing {T, R}.

“فَكَسَوْنَا الْعِظَامَ لَحْمًا” (*fakasaunal-izaama lahma*): we adorn the bones with flesh (23:14), i.e. “we cover bones with flesh”.

“الْكَشْطُ” (*al-kasht*): to remove something that is covering something.

“كَشَطَ الْغَطَاءَ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ” (*kashatal-ata'a unish shaiyi*): he removed the lid off that thing.

“كَشَطَ الْجِلْدَ عَنِ الْجَزُورِ” (*kashatal-jilda unil jazoor*): he skinned the slaughtered camel.

“الْكِشَاطُ” (*al-kishat*): the skinned skin.

“كَشَطَهُ” (*kashatahu*): he opened him {T, R}.

“إِنْكَشَطَ رَوْعَهُ” (*inkashata rau'u*): fear left him {R}.

For example the Quran has used this term in (81:11) by saying, ‘when the world on high is unveiled’. This way the hidden forces (knowledge) in the universe will get exposed or known.

“الْكَشْفُ” (*al-kashf*): to lift the veil, or to disclose something {T}.

The Quran says:

50:22	We lifted the veil from your eyes and thus the truth dawned upon you	فَكَشَفْنَا عَنْكَ غِطَاءَكَ
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It also means to remove as surah *Al-airaaf* says:

7:135	If We would remove this punishment ...	لَئِنْ كَشَفْنَا عَنْكَ الرِّجْزَ
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“كَشَفَ الصُّرَّ” (*kashfaz zurri*): to remove the pain (17:56).

“كَاشَفَ” (*kaashif*): one who removes, or disclose (6:17).

The Quran says:

27:44	And she (queen of <i>Saba</i>) uncovered her shins	وَكَشَفَتْ عَنْ سَاقَيْهَا
68:42	The time period shall be uncovered from the shin	يَوْمَ يُكْشَفُ عَنْ سَاقٍ

This was an Arabic proverb which was spoken when a very difficult situation was faced {T, R}.

Raghib has said that it has come from “قَامَتِ الْحَرْبُ عَلَى سَاقٍ” (*qaamatil hurbu ala saaq*), which literally means that the battle stood on its calf. In other words it means that it went into full cry.

“سَاقُ امْرٍ” (*saaqun amr*): intense. Some say that it has come from “تَذْمِيرُ النَّاقَةِ” (*tazmirun naaqah*) which means for a man to reach inside the womb of a camel and deliver its baby.

At such a time “كَشَفَ عَنِ السَّاقِ” (*kushifa unis saaq*) is said {R}. However, it means intensity and to be troubled.

There is no support from the Quran for the concept of “كشف” (*kashf*) and “الهام” (*ilhaam*) which is prevalent in some parts of the Islamic world. To believe that after the termination of messenger hood anybody can have direct knowledge from God is equivalent to denying the end of messenger hood, because only a messenger can get direct revelation from God. Now as the messenger-hood has been terminated, man can only learn from two sources, (1) from the Quran based on the revelation, (2) the human intellect. See details in heading (*L-He-M*).

“الْكُظْمُ” (*al-kazm*) or “الْكَظْمُ” (*al-kazam*): throat or mouth, or the opening from which the breath comes out {T}, {Lataif-ul-Lugha}. It basically means for something to exit.

“الْكُظْمُ” (*al-kuzum*): for the breath to stop {R}.

“كَظَمَ الْبَعِيرُ” (*kazamal-ba-eer*): for the camel not to munch, and to stop inside that which it has eaten {R}.

“كَظَمَ الْبَابُ” (*kazammal-baab*): to close a door {M}.

“الْكُظْمُ” (*al-kuzum*): to be quiet {M}.

“الْكَازِمُ” (*al-kazim*): a camel whose water in the stomach has dried up and it is very thirsty {T}.

“كَظِيمٌ” (*kazeem*) and “مَكْظُومٌ” (*makzoom*): a very sad, troubled, restless and thoughtful man {M}.

The Quran says:

40:17	When their hearts will be in their mouths and they will be intensely worried (they will be holding their hearts lest they come out).	إِذِ الْقُلُوبُ لَدَى الْحَنَاجِرِ كَازِمِينَ
68:49	He was restless and troubled	وَهُوَ مَكْظُومٌ
12:84	He was restless due to separation from his son <i>Yusuf</i> .	فَهُوَ كَظِيمٌ

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* describes a characteristic of the *momineen*:

3:133	when these forces surge in them they channel them to constructive work	كَازِمِينَ الْغَيْظَ
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Ordinarily it is taken to mean those who suppress their anger. This is not the right meaning. The Quran does not advocate suppressing anger. For the right meaning of this verse one has to understand the meaning of “كَظَامَةٌ” (*kizaamah*). In countries where water is scarce (like in *Saudi Arabia*) a well is dug near an existing well and a subterranean channel is built between them which joins the two wells. If the water in a well decreases, then the water from the well which has relatively more water transfers to this well. This channel is called “كَظَامَةٌ” (*kizaamah*) {T, F}.

Therefore the channelization is called “كَظَامَةٌ” (*kizaamah*). In modern day language or psychology this is called sublimation, i.e. “to drive the excessive forces into another channel and thus maintain the balance”. It also means “the needle of a scale” which indicates the weight as to which is heavier. When both the scales are equal in weight, this needle stops in the middle {T, F}.

“الْكُظَيْمَةُ” (*al-kazeema*) also means a tiffin box in which additional food is kept. Thus “كَازِمِينَ الْغَيْظَ” (*kaazimeenal-ghaiz*) would mean those who channel excess energy into channels where it is required and thus maintain the balance of a society. The Quranic society keeps an eye on these excessive forces and diverts them where they are needed so that balance is maintained and affairs remain right. Thus there will be balance not only in a man’s personality but also in a society, and the party of the *momineen* will become “الْكُظَايِمِينَ الْغَيْظَ” (*al-kaazimeenal-ghaiz*). Remember that rational means to have right ratio.

Since the *momineen* maintain the balance in their personality as well as in the society, thus everything they do is rational, and this ratio is maintained through “كَظِيمَةٌ” (*kizaamat*). “حَسَنٌ” (*husn*) is used for a condition when the balance is right. That is why the Quran has termed “حَسَنَاتٌ” (*hasanat*) to deeds of virtue and goodness, and the attributes of Allah have been called “أَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَى” (*asma ul hasanaat*), or the balanced traits. Details of these matters can be found under the heading (H-S-N).

“الْكُعْبُ” (*al-ka’ab*): joint of bones, or bridge of the foot or the junction of foot and ankle.

Surah *Al-ma’idah* says:

5:6	Both ankles	كُعْبَيْنِ
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“الْكُعْبُ” (*al-ka’ab*), “الْكُعْبَةُ” (*al-ka’abah*): square piece of bone which has figures on it and which is thrown while playing a game of chance (dice) {T}.

“كُعْبَةٌ” (*ka’bah*): high and square place, or every square house {T}, but “الْكُعْبَةُ” (*al-ka’bah*) has become particular to the house of “كُعْبَةٌ” (*kabah*)

“الْكُعْبُ” (*al-ka’ab*): respect and seniority.

“الْكُعْبُ” (*al-ku’ab*): raised breast.

“الْكَاِِبُ” (*al-kaa-ib*): a young girl. Plural is “كَوَاعِبُ” (*kawa-ib*).

Surah *An-naba* calls a women of a heavenly society as “كَوَاعِبُ اَنْرَابًا” (*kawa-iba atraba*) in (78:33).

At another place they have been called “عُرُبًا اَنْرَابًا” (*uruban atraaba*) in (56:37) and it has been explained by saying a little earlier “فُرُشٌ مَرْفُوعَةٌ” (*furushin marfu’a*) in (56:34), that is, high ranking, lofty women. That is why “الْكُعْبُ” (*al-ka’ab*) also has the connotation of the health of youth and respect too. See heading (*Ain-R-B*) and (*T-R-B*). As to what is the right status of the “كُعْبَةُ” (*ka’bah*), see heading (*Q-B-L*).

“كَافَأَهُ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*kafa’ahu alash shaiyi*), “مَكْفَأَةً” (*mak-ufat*), “كِفَاءً” (*kifa’a*): he returned it.

“كَافَأَهُ” (*kaa’fa’ahu*): he equalled him, became equal to him.

“تَكَافَأَ الشَّيْءَانِ” (*takafa’ash shaitan*): both things became equal. These are its basic meanings.

“كُفُوهُ” (*kufuhu*), “كَفُوهُ” (*kafuhu*), “كِفُوهُ” (*kifuhu*): like it, or similar to it.

“الْكِفَاءَةُ فِي النِّكَاحِ” (*al-kafaa’atu fin nikaah*) has been derived from it which means for a husband to be equal to a wife in lineage, etc. {T}.

The Quran says about Allah:

112:4	Nobody is like him, there is no parallel	وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌ
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This is one of His personality traits. Every personality is unique, and since Allah’s personality is complete and absolute, therefore its individuality is also unique. Surah *Ikhlaas* especially defines the uniqueness of Allah’s personality. Not being born of a mother shows that personality does not come into being as a matter of physical birth and “كُفُوًا” (*kufuwan*) points to its individuality. For further details see relevant headings.

“كَفَتَ الشَّيْءُ إِلَيْهِ” (*kafatash shaiya ilaih*): thing inside it.

“كَفَتَ الشَّيْءُ” (*kafatash shaiyi*): seized the thing, or gathered it {T}.

Raghib says “كَفَتُ” (*kagfat*) also means to drive fast.

“كَفَتَ الطَّائِرُ” (*kafatat ta’ir*): the bird gathered its wings and flew speedily.

“الْكِفَاتُ” (*al-kifaat*): the place where something is gathered.

“كِفَاتُ الْأَحْيَاءِ” (*kifaatil ahya*) was said to be houses.

“كِفَاتُ الْأَمْوَاتِ” (*kifaatul amwaat*): means grave {T}.

The Quran says:

77:25	Have we not made the earth a <i>kifaat</i> ?	أَلَمْ نَجْعَلِ الْأَرْضَ كِفَاتًا
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It means that God has gathered many things in earth like plants, animals, water, air, etc.

As said earlier “كَفَّتَ الطَّائِرُ” (*kafatat ta'ir*): the bird flew fast (and in doing so gathered its wings).

“فَرَسٌ كُفْتُ” (*farasun kufat*): a horse which bucks suddenly and it becomes difficult for the rider to be stable {T}. Therefore “كَفَاتُ” (*kifaat*) in relation to the earth would mean that it is moving fast. If the two meanings are gathered together then the meaning would be that it is moving with all the things within it.

K-F-R ك ف ر

“كُفِرَ” (*kufir*): to hide and cover.

Ar Rumaani says that “أَخْفَى” (*akhfaa*) and “سَتَرَ” (*satar*) and “أَجَنَّ” (*ajann*) as the alternatives to “كَفَرَ” (*kufir*) {*Al-Alfaaz Mutaraadifa*}.

Ibn Faris too says the basic meanings are to hide and cover. Therefore a man whose body is hidden due to the armour he wears is called “كَافِرٌ” (*kaafir*). It also means the river and the sea because they hide a lot of things within them. The night is also called “كَافِرٌ” (*kaafir*) because its darkness covers everything. The farmer is also called “كَافِرٌ” (*kaafir*) because he hides a seed in soil {T}.

“الْكُفْرُ” (*al-kufir*): grave according to *Taj* and *Lataif-ul-Lugha*. In the light of these meanings a “كَافِرٌ” (*kaafir*) as against a *momin* is who wants to hide hard facts. He who hides the permanent truths given by God and does not permit them to become highlighted, or one who hides his own and other's abilities and not allow them to be manifested, or does not let them develop.

From the meaning of hiding it also came to mean to deny.

“كُفِرَ” (*kufir*) against “إِيمَانٌ” (*iman*) also means denial. That is, to deny the Quranic truths. “كُفِرَ” (*kufir*) is also used against “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) because “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) means for something to be evident. See heading (*Sh-K-R*).

“كُفِرَانَ نِعْمَةٍ” (*kufiran-e-naimat*): to hide the benevolence, or not to keep them open for the benefit of mankind.

“كَفَّارَةٌ” (*kaffara*): to hide or cover the results of a bad deed {T}.

“كَفَرَ” (*kafar*) has three nouns, “كُفْرَانٌ” (*kufraan*), “كُفْرٌ” (*kufir*) and “كُفُورٌ” (*kufur*).

“كُفْرَانٌ” (*kufraan*) is generally used to deny the benevolence, and “كُفْرٌ” (*kufir*) to deny the *Deen* matters while “كُفُورٌ” (*kufur*) is used to mean both {T}.

Taj says with reference to *Albasa-ir* that often the plural of “كَافِرٌ” (*kaafir*) i.e. the deniers of *Deen* are “كُفَّارٌ” (*kuffaar*) as in (48:29), which is the plural of “كَافِرٌ” (*kaafir*).

“كَفَرَةٌ” (*kafarah*): deniers of benevolence {T}, as in (80:42).

But I think that the Quran uses all these terms like “كُفَّارٌ” (*kuffar*), “كَفَرَةٌ” (*kafarah*), and “كَافِرُونَ” (*kaafiroon*) to mean the deniers of *Deen*.

“كَافُورٌ” (*kaafur*): the covering which is around flower bud {T}. But it is also the name of a medicine which reduces the heat.

“كَفُورٌ” (*kafur*): very unthankful, or being denier of truth. It has the exaggeration of being more than a “كَافِرٌ” (*kaafir*) as in (31:34).

“كَفُورٌ” (*kaffar*) also means the same as “كَفُورٌ” (*kafur*), but it has more intensity than “كَفُورٌ” (*kafur*) as in (50:24) {R}.

The Quran has used “كُفْرٌ” (*kufir*) against “إِيمَانٌ” (*iman*) at several places, such as in (3:4), (2:6), and against “شُكْرٌ” (*shukr*) as in (14:7).

Surah *Al-ambia* says about a *momin*:

21:94	he will be repaid in full (they will not remain unpaid or without results (<i>shukr</i>))	فَلَا كُفْرَانَ لِسَعْيِهِ
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It means to get full results for efforts. Verse (3:114) also means this. That is, “their every good deed will produce full results”.

In surah *Al-baqarah*, “*kufir bit-taghoot*” has been stressed (2:256). This has been clarified in other places:

The Quran says:

16:36	Avoid evil forces	كُفْرٌ بِالطَّاغُوتِ
4:60	these people want their matters to be decided by evil forces although they have been asked to abstain from these	يُرِيدُونَ أَنْ يُتَحَكَّمُوا إِلَى الطَّاغُوتِ وَقَدْ أُمِرُوا أَنْ يَكْفُرُوا بِهِ

“إِيمَانٌ بِاللَّهِ” (*iman bil laah*): to decide according to the laws of Allah.

“كُفْرٌ بِالطَّاغُوتِ” (*kufir bit taghoot*): to avoid evil forces (against the Quranic values)

This shows that “إيمان” (*iman*) and “كفر” (*kufir*) are not mere concepts but practical matters that are not confined to the mind only i.e. not confined to just beliefs. They are related to life’s conceptual and practical issues.

To believe in the veracity of the laws of the Quran and then to live according to them is *iman* and to go against them is *kufir*. Therefore “كَفَرٌ” (*kafar*) has come against “عَمِلَ صَالِحًا” (*amila saleha*) in (30:44). It also means to be free of something.

Surah *Ibrahim* says:

14:22	you make me a partner (in your deeds or beliefs) but I am free of it	إِنِّي كَفَرْتُ بِمَا أَشْرَكْتُمُونِ
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“كُفَّارٌ” (*kuffar*) is the plural of “كَافِرٌ” (*kaafir*) has been used in (57:20). Plural of “كَافِرَةٌ” (*kaafirah*) is “كَوَافِرَةٌ” (*kawafir*) as in (60:10).

“كَفَّارَةٌ” (*kaffarah*): the deed or thing which atones for an error (5:45).

Surah *Al-Insaan* says the flavour of the ‘wine of *jannat*’ is “كَافُورًا” (*kaafura*) in (76:5). This means that one which soothes. But this is the first phase of human reform. The next stage is in which this wine’s flavour is described as “زَنْجَبِيلًا” (*zanjeela*) in (76:17), which means one which produces balanced power and energy.

The balance between two extremes e.g. freezing cold and heat is a *momin*’s trait.

According to the Quran the word *kaafir* is not a bad word or an abuse, but a statement of fact – it describes a state of thought of an individual who does not wish accept a way of life. If you form a part then those who join it are called members and those who do not, are called non-members. The members of an *Islamic* society are called *momin* whereas those who refuse to be member of this party are called *kaafirs*.

The punishment that these *kaafirs* or *non members* face or await is due to their own wrong path which they adopt instead of the right way. That is, they leave the right way (2:38) and adopt the wrong path and thus face destruction (2:271) as a consequence of their own thoughts and deeds.

“كَفَّرَ عَنْهُ” (*kaffara unhu*): to remove (2:271).

The Quran has used the word “كفر” (*kufar*) against the term “عَمِلَ صَالِحًا” (*amali swaleh*) in (30:44). Therefore *iman* and *kufar* are not merely theoretical concepts but actually are the definitions of the righteous belief and the wrong belief.

At the beginning of surah *Al-baqrah* it is said that the Quran guides those towards the right path who wish to be protected from the destructive or wrong path.

The next verse says:

2:6	for the <i>kaafirs</i> it is the same whether you show them the right path or not, they will never have <i>iman</i>	إِنَّ الدِّينَ كَفَرُوا سَوَاءٌ عَلَيهِمْ أُنْذِرْتَهُمْ أَمْ لَمْ تُنْذِرْهُمْ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ
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“كافر” (*kaafir*) are generally thought to be *non-muslims* i.e. those who do not have faith. Do not accept *Islam*. This raises the question that if preaching is not for those who deny then who is the preaching for. Since it does no good to the deniers and the *momineen* do not need it? Also when the messenger *Muhammed* started preaching then the whole world was “كافر” (*kaafir*). If the messenger’s invitation was useless for the “كفار” (*kafar*) then the purpose for messenger hood is itself defeated?

These views indicate that in this verse “كُفَّارٌ” (*kuffar*) did not mean all *non-muslims*. “كُفَّارٌ” (*kuffar*) is thus the name of a particular group among the *non-muslims*. So far as *non-muslims* are concerned the aborigines of *Africa* and *Australia* and the *Eskimos* of north-*America* do not yet know what a *muslim* is and they are *non-muslims*. But they will not be counted among the “كُفَّارٌ” (*kuffar*). As mentioned earlier “كُفَّارٌ” (*kuffar*) appears as against *iman*. Take a man who is presented with the truths of the Quran. He is told their meanings and connotations. He accepts them willingly. This is called *iman*. As against this take another man who is similarly told the truths of the Quran, but he refuses to accept them. This is called *kufar* or denial. There are several reasons for such refusal. These reasons have been detailed at different places in the Quran. The Quran has also said that they oppose the truth and are rebellious of the truth. Not only do they themselves abstain from accepting the truth but also prevent others from accepting it.

This shows that every *non-muslim* is not a *kaafir*. *Kaafirs* are only those who refute the truth and do not accept *Islam* despite all the reasoning and evidence. The Quran has mentioned this mind-set of the *kuffar* and their inner struggle against it.

1) About those with the book it says:

2:89	When that which they recognized came to them then they refuse to accept it	فَلَمَّا جَاءَهُمْ مَا عَرَفُوا كَفَرُوا بِهِ
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At another place it is said that they want the *muslims* who had accepted *iman* to revert to the old ways:

2:109	even after that truth came to them as evident	مِنْ بَعْدِ مَا تَبَيَّنَ لَهُمُ الْحَقُّ---
47:32	those who adopt the path of denial, after the guidance has come to them	إِنَّ الدِّينَ كَفَرُوا--- مِنْ بَعْدِ مَا تَبَيَّنَ لَهُمُ الْهُدَى

These places make it clear that to deny after truth has come is *kufar*. The truth is that the Quran has distinguished between the truth and the *kufar*, after that truth has been manifested.

The Quran says:

18:29	Now tell them that the truth has arrived from you Sustainer. Now whosoever wants can believe and whosoever wants can adopt the way of <i>kufar</i> .	وَقُلِ الْحَقُّ مِنْ رَبِّكُمْ- فَمَنْ شَاءَ فَلْيُؤْمِنْ وَمَنْ شَاءَ فَلْيُكْفُرْ
76:3	We have shown man the way, now it is up to him whether to value it or if wants he can refuse to do so	إِنَّا هَدَيْنَاهُ السَّبِيلَ إِنَّمَا شَاكَرَ وَإِنَّمَا كَفَرَ
43:30	And when the truth came to them they said it is a lie and we refute it	وَلَمَّا جَاءَهُمُ الْحَقُّ قَالُوا هَذَا سِحْرٌ وَإِنَّا بِهِ كَاذِبُونَ

These instances show that **kuf**r is to deny the truth after it has manifested itself clearly. Those who have not faced truth at all, although on the wrong path, are not **kaafirs**.

They will be counted among the “ضَالِّينَ” (**zwallleen**) i.e. those who have lost the way, or those who traverse the wrong path.

2) In surah **At-taubah**, those with **iman** have been told not to befriend even their fathers and brothers:

9:23	If they prefer kuf r against iman	إِنْ اسْتَحَبُّوا الْكُفْرَ عَلَى الْإِيمَانِ
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This makes evident that **kuf**r is something which is also done deliberately.

Surah **An-nahal** says “كُفْرَ” (**kuf**r) is for him whose:

16:106	Those who open their chests to kuf r (embraces kuf r willingly)	مَنْ شَرَحَ بِالْكُفْرِ صَدْرًا
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- 3) Therefore **kuf**r is something which is accepted willingly and deliberately. The **kuf**r or deliberate denial has many reasons e.g. regarding the people of the book the Quran says that due to arrogance or prejudice they do it (2:90).

Regarding the common Arabs who opposed the message, the Quran has noted e.g. (35:42) that they had acquired a position of power through exploitation and force and did not wish to give it up. Also see (45:31).

Surah **An-namal** says:

27:14	They denied our verses out of sheer rebelliousness even though that their hearts had believed in them	وَحَدُّوا بِهَا وَاسْتَفْتَتْهَا أَنْفُسُهُمْ ظُلُمًا وَعُلُوًّا
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4) Sometimes a man refuses to accept something in the heat of the argument, that is, if once no is said then the denial will continue because of the first denial. Such people have been mentioned in **Sursh Al-airaaf**:

7:101	and verily messengers came to them with evident reasoning but they were not such as to accept something which they had once denied.	وَلَقَدْ جَاءَهُمْ رَسُولُهُمْ بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ - فَمَا كَانُوا لِيُؤْمِنُوا بِمَا كَذَّبُوا مِنْ قَبْلُ
7:101	This sort of mentality results in their intellects and hearts being locked.	كَذَلِكَ يَطْبَعُ اللَّهُ عَلَى قُلُوبِ الْكَافِرِينَ

5) These people deny truth due to dogmatism, jealousy, and adamant and pride and also stop others from it lest they accept it.

6:26	They not only stay away from it but also prevent others (from going near it)	وَهُمْ يَنْهَوْنَ عَنْهُ وَيَنْهَوْنَ عَنْهُ
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At another place it is said:

47:32	Verily those who adopt the way of kuf r and stop others too from the way of Allah (hurt only themselves as they can't do any harm to Allah)	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا وَصَدُّوا عَنْ سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ
47:32	They keep telling others not to heed the Quran.	وَقَالَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا لَا تَسْمَعُوا لِهَذَا الْقُرْآنِ
47:32	And wherever it is being propagated, make much noise	وَالْعَوَافِيهِ

“لَعَلَّكُمْ تَغْلِبُونَ” (**la'allakum tughliboon**): perhaps you can overpower them in this way (41:26).

These are the people whom:

2:6	Whether you make them aware about the destructive path they are traversing or not , it is the same for them (they will never listen)	سَوَاءٌ عَلَيْهِمْ أُنذَرْتَهُمْ أَمْ لَمْ تُنذِرْهُمْ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ
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This is, because the way they are going, results in their losing the faculties of seeing, hearing sand understanding (2:7).

These are the people about whom the Quran has said:

7:179	Their destination is jahannam or hell, they have minds but they do not use them to understand. They have eyes but they do not see. They have ears but they do not hear (the truth): These people appear to be humans but actually they behave like animals, rather even more misled, because at least the animals follow their instincts.	هَمْ قُلُوبٌ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ بَيِّنَاتٍ - وَهُمْ أَعْيُنٌ لَا يُبْصِرُونَ بَيِّنَاتٍ وَهُمْ أَذَانٌ لَا يَسْمَعُونَ بَيِّنَاتٍ أُولَئِكَ كَالْأَنْعَامِ بَلْ هُمْ أَضَلُّ
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The question now is, what is the life of **kufr**? There is a physical life in which one eats, drinks, lives, has children and then dies. That is the end. Another concept is that life is just not the corporeal self. There is another thing in humans which is called personality. By nurturing or developing that personality man can have life forever. Death as we know it, makes no difference to personality. Animals have no personality. God has only bestowed it on humans by providing free will which is the ability to make choices.

In **kufr** man exists at an animal level:

47:12	Those who live the life of kufr enjoy life and die after eating and drinking. Their destination is jahannam or hell. They do not wish to believe in the higher values of life. They pursue their desires. And get so immersed in these emotions that they lose the faculty of thought and deliberation	وَالَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا يَتَمَتَّعُونَ وَيَأْكُلُونَ كَمَا تَأْكُلُ الْأَنْعَامُ - وَالنَّارُ مَثْوًى لَهُمْ
47:12	Have you ever wondered about him who has turned his desires into his god?	أَفَرَأَيْتَ يَتَّخِذُ إِلَهَهُ هَوَاهُ

The result of doing so is

45:23	The law of Allah, despite his knowledge, doesn't bring forth the right way of life before him?	وَأَضَلَّهُ اللَّهُ عَلَى عِلْمٍ
45:23	By being engulfed in desires his condition becomes so that his ears are like they are sealed and his eyes are like they are veiled	وَحَتَمَ عَلَى سَمْعِهِ وَقَلْبِهِ وَجَعَلَ عَلَى بَصَرِهِ غِشَاوَةً
45:23	And obviously no other law excepting that of God can lead him to the right path	فَمَنْ يَهْدِيهِ مِنْ بَعْدِ اللَّهِ
45:23	Do these people not learn from this?	أَفَلَا تَذَكَّرُونَ

Why do people pursue their desires and do not follow the road to the higher values of life? Because:

45:24	And they say the life is only in this world	وَقَالُوا مَا هِيَ إِلَّا حَيَاتُنَا الدُّنْيَا
45:24	(they say) we live and die according to the physical laws.	نَمُوتُ وَنَحْيَا
45:24	With the passage of time our limbs weaken and we ultimately die.	وَمَا يُهْلِكُنَا إِلَّا الدَّهْرُ

This is their concept of life. The Quran says:

45:24	They have no knowledge about the reality. All this is guess work	وَمَا لَهُمْ بِذَلِكَ مِنْ عِلْمٍ إِنْ هُمْ إِلَّا يَظُنُّونَ
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Also see (6:29).

This is what **kufr** is, i.e., the denial by one with regard to his own personality. After this denial there is no need for belief in Allah (2:177, 28:50), or the revelation or even messenger-hood. And then the question of belief in the life hereafter does not even arise. As such **kufr** is the other name for materialism. According to this concept, only the satisfaction of one's desires is the purpose of life and there is no question of adhering to the high ideals of life as revealed in the Quran. When man takes this concept as the truth, then to make him aware of the deeds which hurt the lofty ideals of life is as good as not telling him. You cannot teach an animal to be honest and that dishonesty leads to ignominy!

“الْكُفُّ” (*al-kaff*): the hand from the elbow to the palm (13:14). A man uses it to defend himself and prevent another from hurting others.

“كَفَفْتُهُ عَنْهُ” (*kafaf-tuhu unhu*): I prevented him from it (5:11), or moved him, or turned him away.

“فَكَفَّ هُوَ” (*fa kaffa huwa*): so he stopped.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to hold and condense {T}.

“كُفٌّ” (*kuff*): the hand, because it holds things.

“الْكُفْفَةُ” (*al-kuffah*): extremity of anything that something can't exceed.

This is also called “كِفَافُ الشَّيْءِ” (*kiffush shjaiyi*).

“كِفْفَةٌ” (*kiffah*): one of the balances of scales.

“كَأَفَّةٌ” (*ka'affah*): something which takes another thing to its extreme.

The Quran says:

9:36	Do battle with the <i>mushrikeen</i> so that it stops them from oppression or which stops affecting you.	وَقَاتِلُوا الْمُشْرِكِينَ كَافَّةً كَمَا يُقَاتِلُونَكُمْ كَافَّةً
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This would mean fight to the last. *Raghib* says it means to fight the *mushrikeen* with collective strength, i.e. collectively or as a group.

According to the general dictionaries the meaning of “كَأَفَّةً” (*ka'affah*) in this verse is “total” or “whole”.

But the Quran calls for battling with the *mushrikeen* who are opposing and at war, and not every *mushrik* anywhere.

2:208	Reach the extreme limit in <i>Islam</i> . (do not stop midway but reach the limit)	ادْخُلُوا فِي السِّلْمِ كَافَّةً
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Raghib says that it means collectively:

34:28	We have sent you as the one who prevents sins {R}.	وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَاكَ إِلَّا كَافَّةً لِّلنَّاسِ
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“كَافَّةً” (*kaffah*) has appeared to mean prevent or to stop (21:39, 48:24). It has also been used against

“بَسِطَ” (*bast*) in (5:11).

“الْكُفْفُ مِنَ الرِّزْقِ” (*al-kafafa minar rizq*): that amount of sustenance which prevents man from becoming dependant on other human beings {T}.

“الْكُفُّ” (*al-kuffu*): benevolence.

“الْكُفْلُ” (*al-kafil*): the hip or the lower part of the hip {T}.

“اِكْتَفَلَ بِهِ” (*iktafal-bihi*): drove him or pushed him back {T}.

“الْكَاْفِلُ” (*al-kaafil*) or “الْكُفَيْلُ” (*al-kafeel*): responsible for or guarantor.

“كَفَّلَهُ” (*kaffalahu*): looked after him, spent for him {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means for something to be included into another thing or merge with it.

The Quran says:

28:12	Those who get it, happen to have it may nurture it.	يَكْفُلُونَهُ
16:61	you have made Allah your guarantor	قَدْ جَعَلْتُمُ اللَّهَ عَلَيْكُمْ كَفِيلًا
38:23	hand over that sheep to me	اَكْفُلْنِيهَا
3:36	put <i>maryam</i> under <i>zakaria</i> 's patronage	وَكَفَّلَهَا زَكَرِيَّا

“الْكِفْلُ” (*al-kifl*): share, luck. This is said when along with one somebody else is also given {T} (4:85).
 “كِفْلَيْنِ” (*kiflain*): two shares (57:28).

Raghib says “كِفْلَيْنِ” (*kiflain*) means “not two shares but the continuity of benevolence” and it also has the connotation as needed.

Surah *Al-ambia* mentions the name “ذَا الْكِفْلِ” (*zalkifl*) in (21:85) in the context of messengers. Some think this is *Hazqeel* who has been mentioned in the *Torah* {R}. Some say that “ذَا الْكِفْلِ” (*zulkifl*) is an indication towards *Kapila vastu* or *Budha*.

Since the Quran has not gone into details about him, so no need to discuss it any further. Also see heading “ذَا الْكِفْلِ” (*zalkifl*).

K-F-Y ك ف ي

“الْكِفَايَةُ” (*al-kifaayah*): the thing which fulfils the need and purpose {R}.

Ibn Faris says the root means for a thing to be in the required quantity to fulfil the need so nothing else is needed.

“كَفَاكَ الشَّيْءُ يَكْفِيكَ” (*kafakush shaiy'u yakfeek*): for you, that thing is enough.

“الْكَفْيَةُ” (*al-kufyah*): food which is sufficient for life.

“كَفَاهُ مُنَاتَهُ” (*kafahu munatah*): that man undertook his hard work and saved him from the toil {T}.

“كَفَيْتَهُ شَرَّ عَدُوِّهِ” (*kafaitahu sharra uduwwahi*): I protected him from his enemy's harm and saved him {T}.

“رَجُلًا كَافٍ وَكَفَى” (*rajulun wa kaafin wa kaffi*): something that is sufficient for you after which you do not need anything.

“كَافَاهُ مُكَافَاةً” (*kaafahu mukafah*): he was sufficient for him {M}.

“الْكَفْيُ” (*al-kaffi*): rain.

“كَفَى عَنْهُ الشَّيْءُ” (*kafa unhush shaiyi*): removed or turned that thing away from him {T}.

The Quran says:

15:95	We are enough to protect you from their acts. (Our law which you are following will protect you against them and you will also achieve your aim).	إِنَّا كَفَيْنَاكَ الْمُسْتَهْزِئِينَ
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In “كَفَى” (*kafa*) both these things are included. The very same thing is said in (2:137).

Surah *Az-zumr* says:

39:36	Those who obey Allah's guidance the Law of Requitat not only protects but also helps achieve its purpose	الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا بِاللَّهِ بِكَافٍ عَبْدَهُ
39:36	These people frighten you with non-Godly forces; there is no cause to fear them	وَيُخَوِّفُونَكَ بِالَّذِينَ مِنْ دُونِهِ

This is the basic characteristic of following Allah's Guidance. Surah *Ar-raad* says:

13:43	Allah is enough for <i>shahadat</i> or overseeing	كَفَى بِاللَّهِ شَهِيدًا
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The Quran provides the guidance in this life which provides all the necessary protection against the destructive forces and also helps in the self-development. Since this life and the next life are joined together therefore the Quran gives glad tidings to the believers in both parts of the life (16:97). This is all explained in the Quran in detail.

“كَلَّأَ” (*kala*), “يَكْلَأُ” (*yakla*), “كَلَأَ” (*kalan*), “كِلَاءٌ” (*kilaa-un*) and “كِلَاءَةٌ” (*kila’atan*): to protect, guard, or to watch over {T}.

“الْمَكَلَلَةُ” (*al-makalla’u*): the bank of a canal, beach, port or any place where sanctuary is sought {M}{T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to hang on to something very strongly.

The Quran says:

21:42	Who protects you? (Who is your guardian?)	مَنْ يَكْلَلُكُمْ
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“الْكَلْبُ” (*al-kalb*): a grip with which goods are hanged. Also used for dog. Lion.

“الْكَلْبَةُ مِنَ الْعَيْشِ” (*al-kulbatu minal-aish*): the paucity of earning {T}.

“الْمُكَلِّبُ” (*al-mukallib*): a trainer who trains hunting dogs. Later it came to mean “to train every hunting animal”.

Surah *Al-ma'idah* says:

5:4	(and it has been allowed for you) that which you train your hunting dogs to hunt for you by the virtue of the knowledge that has been endowed to you by Allah	وَمَا عَلَّمْتُمْ مَنِ الْجَوَارِحِ مُكَلِّبِينَ تُعَلِّمُونَهُنَّ مِمَّا عَلَّمَكُمُ اللَّهُ---
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Another thing that is notable in this verse is that it says “you teach or train dogs by virtue of the knowledge which you have been endowed by Allah”. Obviously this knowledge is not imparted directly to the trainers. He has endowed man with the ability to learn. Now man, if he so wants, can learn it. Allah has made a reference to himself because he has given man the potential to learn. Therefore that which a man does as per the laws fixed by Allah, can be attributed to Him. By comprehending this point we can have clarification about many verses of the Quran, where Allah has related human acts to Himself. For example see (2:222).

“كَلَّحَ” (*kalah*), “يَكْلُحُ” (*yaklah*), “كُلُوحًا” (*kuluhan*), “كُلَاحًا” (*kulaha*): to bare one’s front teeth in anger, or to make a face, or to make a very bad face. “الْكَوْلُحُ” (*al-kaulah*): an ugly man. “الْكُلَاَحُ” (*al-kulaah*): drought years.

Ibn Faris too has said that this root means a terse and ugly face.

Surah *Al-mominoon* says:

23:104	they will be making faces at this	هُمْ فِيهَا كَاكِفُونَ
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- “الْكَلْفُ” (*al-kalf*): blackish yellowness.
 “الْكُلْفَةُ” (*al-kulfah*): blackish yellow, or work which is tolerated despite being very laborious. It also means every plight that is tolerated despite the plight or toil.
 “الْكُلُوفُ” (*al-kuluf*): an unpleasant happening.
 “التَّكْلِيفُ” (*at-takleef*): to make some work mandatory which is difficult for someone.
 “تَكَلَّفَ الْأَمْرَ” (*takallafal-amr*): he tolerated work which was very difficult for him to perform.
 “تَكَلَّفَ الشَّيْءَ” (*takallufush shaiyi*): to do something with a pleasant demeanour although doing it may be difficult or unpleasant.
 “كُلْفَةٌ” (*kulfah*): labour and
 “تَكَلَّفَ” (*takalluf*): do something which is done merely for appearance sake.

Surah *Saad* says:

38:86	I am not doing it for appearances only.	وَمَا أَنَا مِنَ الْمُتَكَلِّفِينَ
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At several places in the Quran is said:

2:286	Allah makes nothing mandatory for someone beyond his limit	لَا يَكُلِّفُ اللَّهُ نَفْسًا إِلَّا وُسْعَهَا
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The limit of a person is that which he reaches with ultimate effort, not that a person reaches without trying his best. He should not satisfy himself that Allah does not make more than what his self-proclaimed limit allows him. Human beings have tremendous potentials which are required to be explored through the use of both intellect and physical self.

Raghib says the meaning of this verse is that the limits that Allah fixes for a man are there to create wider scope in his personality for further self-development. Therefore those limits are not for curtailing his freedom but these help create greater potentials for further development. It is just like a ‘fall’ which increases the velocity of the flowing water in a stream. It should be seen with reference to the context in the Quran as to which meaning is more appropriate for this word.

“كُلٌّ” (*kull*): all the parts or elements of a thing, that is, the total. It is used both as masculine and feminine. Sometimes it is used to mean ‘some’.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to surround one thing with another.

“كَلٌّ” (*kall*): lawyer, advocate, statue, a new plight, orphan child, a family man, etc. It also means a useless man who is a pure burden on another and who has no saving grace {T}.

16:67	He is a burden on his boss.	هُوَ كُلٌّ عَلَىٰ مُوَلَّاهُ
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“كُلٌّ” (*kullun*), “كَلَالٌ” (*kalaal*), “كَالَالَةٌ” (*kalalah*): to be fed up of or to be tired of {T}. The Quran uses “الْكَلَالَةُ” (*al-kalalah*) at two places (4:14, 4:177). Scholars have debated at length as to what “كالاله” (*kalah*) means. A group thinks, and most agree with it, that “كالاله” (*kalalah*) means a person who neither has children nor parents {T}.

Ibn Qateebah with reference to *Abu Abeeadah* says that this word has come from “تَكَلَّلَهُ النَّسَبُ” (*takalla latun nasb*) which means “descent reached his environs”. Parents and children are the ends of a man. If he so dies in a state when he neither has parents nor children, then he is called “كالاله” (*kalalah*) {*Al-Qartain*}.

Al-Maghrib says at page 159 vol.2 that an heir excepting the father or child is called “كالاله” (*kalalah*).

Lissan-ul-Arab with reference to ***Akhfash*** and ***Faraa*** maintains that “كلالة” (***kalalah***) means every ‘relative’ which is beside the father or the son.

The Quran has described it in four words. Surah *An-nisa* says:

4:177	If a man dies and he has no children but has a sister, then (her share will be thus)	إِنْ أَمْرُوا هَلَكَ لَيْسَ لَهُ وَلَدٌ لَهُ أُخْتُ فَلَهَا
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At the beginning of this surah it is said:

4:12	If he has a brother or sister then....	وَلَهُ أَخٌ أَوْ أُخْتُ
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Hence there are two conditions to be a “” (*kalalah*). One is that he must have no children and the other is that he must have a brother or a sister. There is no condition about there being a father or mother. If he has parents then according to (4:12) the heirloom will be divided in a different way. If they do not exist then it will be divided in another way.

“أَلَا كَلِيلٌ” (*al-ikeel*): crown.

“أَلَا كَلَالٌ” (*al-kalal*): condition.

“كُلٌّ” (*kul*): “total” as stated above, but sometimes it means “some”.

In the tale about *Ibrahim* where he has been told to fetch birds and train them:

2:260	Then put them all on <i>jabal</i> (hills)	ثُمَّ اجْعَلْ عَلَى كُلِّ جَبَلٍ مِنْهُنَّ
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Here “كُلِّ جَبَلٍ” (*kulli jabalin*) means some mountains. But “كُلٌّ” (*kulli*) could also mean “all”, i.e. at the place it is said, could have only two or four mountains. This would mean “كُلٌّ” (*kulli*) i.e. “all of them”.

Surah *Al-kahaf* says about *Zulqarnain*:

18:84	We had given him all kinds of things.	وَآتَيْنَاهُ مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ سَبَبًا
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Here “كُلِّ شَيْءٍ” (*kulli shaiyi*) does not mean goods of all kinds but the wherewithal of the state and within that wherewithal i.e. ‘some part’ – whatever required for the state.

“إِنْ نَافِيَةٍ” (*un naafiah*) has appeared before “كُلٌّ” (*kull*) followed by “إِلَّا” (*illa*) has appeared, which means that there was none like that.

“كُلُّمَا أَضَاءَ لَهُمْ مَشْوَافِيهِ” (*kullun illa kazzabar rusul*): there was nobody who did not refute the messengers.

This means that all refuted.

“كُلُّمَا” (*kullama*): whenever.

2:20	Whenever it provides the light they follow in that light.	كُلُّمَا أَضَاءَ لَهُمْ مَشْوَافِيهِ
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“كَالًا” (*kalla*) and “كِلَا” (*kilaa*) must be seen under separate headings as they are separate words.

Kalla

كَلَا

1) It generally appears like when we say “No, it is not like that but rather...”:

89:17	Not at all, but the thing is that you do not respect the orphans (you scold, or reject, or demean or insult them)	كَالًا بَلْ لَا تُكْرِمُونَ الْيَتِيمَ
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2) To mean ‘the truth is’, ‘the fact is’:

96:6	The truth is, (actual fact is) that man is rebellious.	كَالًا إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لَيْطَغَى
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3) *Mirza Abul Fazal* with reference to *Nazar bin Shimel* writes that it also means ‘yes’:

102:3	Yes, soon you shall know	كَالًا سَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ
102:4	Then yes, soon you shall know	ثُمَّ كَالًا سَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ
102:5	Yes, if you have the knowledge of certainty	كَالًا لَوْ تَعْلَمُونَ عِلْمَ الْيَقِينِ

These instances disclose the meaning of “كَأَنَّ” (*kalla*), i.e. to deny that which is against the facts and verify the truth.

Killa كَلَا

“كَالَا” (*kilaa*) (masculine), “كَالَتْ” (*kilta*) (feminine) means “both”
 “كَالَاهُمَا” (*kila huma*): both (father and mother) (17:23).
 “كَالَتَا الْجَنَّتَيْنِ” (*kiltal-jannatain*): these two gardens (18:33).

K-L-M ك ل م

“كَلِمَةٌ” (*kalimah*): one word, or one matter, or one sentence, or one eulogy, or one speech.

It is written as “كَلِمَةٌ” (*kalimah*), or “كَلِمَةً” (*kalmah*) or “كَلِمَةً” (*kilmah*).

“كَالَامٌ” (*kalam*): speech {*T, M*}.

“كَالِمَاتٌ” (*kalimaat*) which is plural of “كَلِمَةٌ” (*kalimah*) also means “matters”.

The Quran says:

2:124	When the Sustainer provided <i>Ibrahim</i> with several instances of development of personality or when different aspects of life came before him, or he met different events, or he met with several events, or different matters were made his responsibility.	وَ إِذَا بَتَلَىٰ اِبْرٰهِيْمَ رَبُّهُ بِكَلِمٰتٍ
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“كَالِمَاتٌ” (*kalimaat*) has all these above meanings.

“اَلْكَلْمُ” (*al-kalm*): to injure {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings are “to talk” and “to injure”.

Surah *An-namal* says:

27:82	We shall bring forth for them a creature from this earth speaking to them	اَخْرَجْنَا لَهُمْ دَابَّةً مِّنَ الْاَرْضِ تُكَلِّمُهُمْ
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Here “تُكَلِّمُ” (*tukallim*) can mean “to injure” as well as “to talk”.

For the meaning of this verse see heading (*D-B-B*).

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan says that the connotation of a word which has “ك” (*K*) and “ل” (*L*) and “م” (*M*) is intensity and strength.

“اَلْكَلْمُ” (*al-kalm*) is an example which means strength.

“اَلْكُلَامُ” (*al-kulaam*): harsh land {*Al-ilm-ul-Khafaq*}.

In today’s parlance “كَلِمَةٌ” (*kalimah*) means ideology, as surah *Ibrahim* says.

14:24	A righteous ideology is like a staunch tree (firmly rooted) with branches extending to the heavens.	كَلِمَةً طَيِّبَةً كَشَجَرَةٍ طَيِّبَةٍ اَصْلُهَا ثَابِتٌ وَفُرْعَاهَا فِي السَّمٰوٰتِ
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“كَالَمٌ” (*kalam*): to talk to someone (19:26).

“تَكَلَّمُ” (*takalum*): to converse with someone (24:16).

“تَكْلِيْمٌ” (*takleem*): to talk to somebody (4:164). It is also used to express doubt.

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says:

3:44	O <i>Maryam</i> , Allah heralds good news	إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُبَشِّرُكِ بِكَلِمَةٍ مِنْهُ
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Ahead it is said that the good news is about *Isa (Jesus)*. In Christianity “كَلِمَةً” (*kalima*) Words or Logos are a special term around which the entire philosophy about *Isa*’s patronage revolves. But the Quran does not involve itself into such far-fetched philosophies.

Surah *Yunus* says, as it also appears at other places:

10:33	In this way what your Sustainer said was proven to them	وَكَذَٰلِكَ حَقَّتْ كَلِمَةُ رَبِّكَ
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At these places the *kalimah* of Allah simply means Allah’s saying, but Allah’s sayings are obviously Allah’s laws. Therefore this word has profusely been used to mean Allah’s law. A part of Allah’s law is operative in the universe. These are called laws of nature. The second part of those laws concerns the human world. These laws are revealed through the revelation and are now preserved in the Quran.

About the Quran itself, it is said:

6:116	The laws of Allah have been completed with truth and justice.	وَتَمَّتْ كَلِمَتُ رَبِّكَ صِدْقًا وَعَدًا لَا
6:116	These laws do not change.	لَا مُبَدِّلَ لِكَلِمَتِهِ

This means that with the end of the messenger hood, i.e. when the code of life given by Allah is completed and there can be no change in it, then there is no need for any messenger any more. This also makes it clear that the *momin* group or party is bound to remain within these laws which can never be changed or amended. These very limits determine the freedom and limit of an *Islamic* System as well. Not even the state itself can change any law. But while remaining within these laws, one can, according to the needs of the time, make adjustments as explained in the Quran and through mutual consultation (42:38).

Kam كَمْ

It has following meanings:

- 1) How much (i.e. what quantity).
- 2) How many (number).
- 3) What period (of time).

23:112	How long have you stayed on earth?	كَمْ لَبِثْتُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ
2:249	There were many small parties which overcame bigger parties	كَمْ مِنْ فِئَةٍ قَلِيلَةٍ غَلَبَتْ فِئَةً كَثِيرَةً

“Many” or “several” make the meaning clear.

Kum كُمْ

“ضَرَبَكُم” (*zarabakum*): he beat you all.

“غُلَامُكُمْ” (*ghulamukum*): your *ghulam* (slave, servant).

The Quran says:

48:21	Allah has made you a promise	وَعَدَكُمْ اللَّهُ
3:50	From your Sustainer	مِنْ رَبِّكُمْ

“كُـمَا” (*kuma*) is used for masculine as well as feminine.
 “ضَرَبَكُـمَا” (*zarabukuma*): he beat both of you (men or women).

12:37	Come to both of you	يَا نِيَكُـمَا
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“غُلَامُكُـمَا” (*ghulamukuma*): slave of both of you (for both male and female).

20:47	I am with you both	إِنِّي مَعَكُـمَا
20:49	O <i>Moosa</i> who is your Sustainer (of both of you brothers).	فَمَنْ رُبُّكُـمَا يُؤْتِسِي

“الْكَـمَالُ” (*al-kamaaltu*): be complete.
 “الْكَـمَامُ” (*at-tamaam*) also means the same. For the slight difference between the two see heading (*T-M-M*).
 “كَـمِلَ” (*kamula*): to be complete.
 “أَكْمَلَهُ” (*akmalah*) and “كَـمَلَهُ” (*kammalah*): completed it and made it look good.
 “أَعْطَاهُ الْكَـمَالَ كَمَالًا” (*aa'taahul maala kamala*): gave him the full payment or riches {*T, R*}.

Raghib says “كَـمِلَ ذَالِكُ” (*kamula zaalik*) means “whatever was needed from him was fulfilled” {*Ilm-ul-Khafaq*}.

“لِتُكْمِلُوا الْعِدَّةَ” (*litukmilul iddah*): to complete the count of fasting (days) (2:185).
 “أَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ” (*akmaltu lakum deenakum*) in (5:3) it can have two meanings. One is that the *Deen* is completed for you. This gives evidence of *Islam* being the last and complete *Deen* (way of life). The other meaning is “now you have been made to overpower the opponents completely”, or “your dominance has been made complete”. This is about the group of *momineen* of that time. Then it is said that is why your opponents have been completely disappointed (5:3).

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan says that the connotation of a word which has “كـ” (*K*) and “لـ” (*L*) and “مـ” (*M*) is intensity and strength. The secret to the excellence of something lies in its power {*Ilm-ul-Khafaq*}.

“الْكَـمُّ” (*al-kum*): the sleeve.
 “الْكَـيْمُ” (*al-kim*): the covering of a flower or bud. Its plural is “الْكَـمَامُ” (*akmaam*) as in (41:47, 55:11).
 “كَـمَّتِ النَّخْلَةُ” (*kummatin nakhlah*): the date palm has sprouted buds.
 “مَكْمُومٌ” (*makmoom*): a tree with buds.
 “الْكَـمَامُ” (*al-kimaam*) is the covering on a camel’s mouth to prevent it from biting anyone.
 “الْكَـمَّةُ” (*al-kummah*): round cap {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is for a thing that covers.

“الْكَمَّة” (*al-kamah*): blindness by birth. Such a blind man will be called “الْأَكْمَه” (*al-akmah*). But some say that this word means to be born blind and be blind otherwise as well.

“كَمَةُ النَّهَارِ” (*kamihan nahaar*): the sun was covered by mist and the day became dark.

“كَمِيَ فُلَانٌ” (*kamiha fulanun*): that man lost his intellect, i.e. lost his sight.

“الْأَكْمَه” (*al-kaamih*): the man who gets up and gets going wherever he so wants {*T, M, R*}.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says that *Isa* said to his nation:

3:48	I will grant sight to the blind	وَأُبْرِئُ الْأَكْمَه
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This verse has following meanings, metaphorically speaking:

- I will give sight to those who have lost it.
- I will show those a way who are traversing a path without thinking.
- I will give them a destination.

This is what a messenger does through the revelation. At several places the Quran has called those who are misled as blind and those who traverse the right path as those with sight.

“كَنَدَ الشَّيْءُ” (*kanadal-shaiyi*), “يَكْنُدُهُ” (*yaknudah*): he cut that thing {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says this is its basic meaning.

“كَنَدَ النِّعْمَةَ” (*kanadan ne'mah*): he was ungrateful for the benevolence.

“الْكَنُودُ” (*al-kanuud*): it is said of a man who is a loner. Who doesn't help people and is cruel with the slaves. Or one who recounts the misfortunes but forgets the good things {*T, M*} i.e. ungrateful. It also means the land which does not produce anything.

“الْكِنْدَةُ” (*al-kindah*): a piece of the mountain. {*T, M*}

The Quran says:

100:6	If man is left on his own then he becomes a loner and doesn't share the bounties given by the Sustainer with anyone	إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لِرَبِّهِ لَكَنُودٌ
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This means that he becomes like the barren land which does not produce anything. This is what happens due to being ungrateful in life.

“الْكَنْزُ” (*al-kanz*): buried treasure, or wealth hidden under ground. The plural is “كُنُوزٌ” (*kunuuz*).

“كَانَزَ” (*kanaz*), “يَكْنِزُ” (*yakniz*): to gather riches {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it means to collect in something.

9:34	And those who hoard	وَالَّذِينَ يَكْنِزُونَ
9:35	This is what you have hoarded	هَذَا مَا كَنْزُكُمْ
9:36	What you used to hoard	مَا كُنْتُمْ تَكْنِزُونَ

According to the Quran, for individuals to collect wealth for selfish ends is like preparing a *jahannam* or hell for their self. There is no reason to acquire or collect surplus money in an *Islamic* System. Every man works his utmost in such a society. He takes what he needs from the returns and turns the rest over to the society for the good of fellow beings. The system guarantees all the needs for him and his children. As such there is no need of acquiring or collecting excessive wealth. Note that property is also part of the

wealth. For example housing and their price levels are closely monitored in the developed capitalist countries.

Surah *Al-kahaf* says:

18:28	their buried (hidden) wealth	كَانُوا لَهُمَا
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Surah *Al-qasas* uses “كَانُوا” (*kanuuz*) as well as “مَفَاتِيحُ” (*mafatih*) to mean treasure (28:76). “الْكَنْزُ” (*al-kaneez*): those dates which are stored in baskets or utensils for the winter {*T, M*}.

K-N-S ك ن س

“كَانَسَ الظَّبْيُ يَكْنِسُ” (*kanasaz zabi’u yaknis*): the deer hid in its hiding place (the bushes). “الْكِنَاسُ” (*al-kinas*): wild grass where wild animals take refuge. “الْكِنَاسَةُ” (*al-kanaasah*): garbage dump, or garbage {*M*}.

Ibn Faris says that this root has two basic meanings. One is to remove something from the upper part of something. The second meaning is to hide.

The Quran says:

81:14	Such stars which disappear while revolving (hiding)	الْجَوَارِ الْكُنَّسِ
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See heading (*K-N-S*).

“الْكَنِيسَةُ” (*al-kaneesah*): the place of worship for the Jews or the Christians {*Lataif-ul-Lugha*}. It also means a beautiful woman {*T*}.

Raghib says this word has come from a Greek word *iklisia* which means congregation or a party {*M*}.

K-N-N ك ن ن

“الْكِنُّ” (*al-kinn*), “الْكِنَّةُ” (*al-kinnah*), “الْكِنَانُ” (*al-kinaan*): the covering of everything and veil. “الْكِنُّ” (*al-kinnu*): the place where something is kept safe {*T*}.

The plural for “الْكِنُّ” (*al-kinnu*) is “الْكِنَانُ” (*aknaan*) and for “الْكِنَانُ” (*al-kinaan*) is “الْكِنَّةُ” (*akinnah*): a place of safe keeping (41:5, 17:46, 18:57).

“كَنَّهَ” (*kannah*), “اَكَنَّهَ” (*akannah*): hid it {*T*}.

In 27:74 this word has appeared opposite to “يُعْلِنُونَ” (*yu’linoon*):

27:74	Your Sustainer knows or is aware of the things which you hide in your bosoms and that which you disclose	إِنَّ رَبَّكَ لَيَعْلَمُ مَا تُكِنُّ صُدُورُهُمْ وَمَا يُعْلِنُونَ
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“مَكْنُونٌ” (*maknoon*): safely kept, safe (37:49).

The Quran has been called “كِتَابُ الْمَكْنُونِ” (*kitaab-un-maknoon*) in (56:78), i.e. the book that has been kept safe, or a safe book. This has been also said with words like “فِي لَوْحٍ مَّحْفُوظٍ” (*fi lauhin mahfooz*) in (85:22).

“كُنَّ” (*kunna*): is used for plural feminine present.
 “صَرَبَكُنَّ” (*zarabkun*): he beat you all women.

The Quran says “طَلَّقَكُنَّ” (*tallaqakun*) in (66:5) which means “if he divorces you”.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:28	Verily the machinations of women is great	إِنَّ كَيْدَ نِسَاءٍ عَظِيمٌ
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K-H-F

ك ه ف

“الْكَهْفُ” (*al-kahaf*): a big cave or a house dug out in the mountain. A small cave is called “غَارٌ” (*ghaar*). It also means “sanctuary”.
 “تَكْهَفُ” (*takah haf*), “اِكْتَهَفُ” (*iktahaf*): he entered the cave, or lived in the “كهف” (*kahaf*) {*T, R, M*}.
 “أَصْحَابُ الْكَهْفِ” (*ashaabul kahaf*) has been used in (18:9) to signify young righteous men who sought refuge in a cave. For details see heading (*R-Q-M*).

18:9	Fellowship of the cave	أَصْحَابُ الْكَهْفِ
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K-H-L

ك ه ل

“الْكَهْلُ” (*al-kahl*): middle age as thirty, or the age from thirty (or thirty three) to fifty years.

Azhari says that at this is an age when a man reaches the peak of his youth and abilities, and starts going downhill from there on.

“نَعَجَةٌ مُكْتَهَلَةٌ” (*na'jatun muktahilah*): a sheep that has reached full age {*T, R, M*}.
 “نَبْتُ الْكَهْلِ” (*nabtun kahl*): the plant or tree which has reached the age of full growth {*T, R, M*}.

Ibn Faris says that “كهل” (*kahl*) basically means for strength to be created in something and for its form and structure to be completed.

“الْمُكَاهَلَةُ” (*al-mukahalah*): to wed.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says about *Isa*:

3:45	He will talk to people in a young age as well as in maturity	وَيُكَلِّمُ النَّاسَ فِي الْمَهْدِ وَكَهْلًا
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This shows that *Isa* (Jesus) had started talking against the ills of society from a very young age. As it is, he was endowed with messenger-hood at rather an early age, at of the age of thirty, as history tells us. But the Quran does not mention it.

By saying “كهلا” (*kahla*) the Quran has pointed to the age of 31/32 when according to the jews he was crucified and as the Christians believe he went to the heavens, is not right. He remained among the people till old age and continued talking about his mission and the revelation.

“الْكَاهِنُ” (*al-kaahin*): a man who claimed to know secrets and used to inform about events in the world and the universe. {T}.

Raghib says that “كَاهِنٌ” (*kaahin*) meant a man who tells secrets of past, while “عَرَّافٌ” (*ar-raaf*) was a man who foretold about the future {R}.

Muheet says that among the Jews and the Christians “كَاهِنٌ” (*kaahin*) was a man who used to present animals for sacrifice on behalf of the worshippers. The Arabs used “كَاهِنٌ” (*kaahin*) for a foreteller who told the future by tossing pebbles {M}.

Since the Arabs did not actually understand the importance of the messenger-hood they thought that *Muhammad*, was a “كَاهِنٌ” (*kaahin*) or poet. The Quran refuted it and declared:

52:29	By the grace of Allah, you are not a <i>kaahin</i> nor <i>majnoon</i>	فَمَا أَنْتَ بِنِعْمَتِ رَبِّكَ بِكَاهِنٍ وَلَا مَجْنُونٍ
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Under the prevalent religious environment in some parts of the Muslim world, the one who tells about the future is considered to be closer to Allah – this happens when human beings do not seek guidance from the Quran.

“الْكَوْبُ” (*al-koob*): a cup with no handle {T, R}. The plural is “أَكْوَابٌ” (*akwaab*).

The Quran says “أَكْوَابٌ” (*akwaab*) in (43:71) where it has been used for such cups.

“كَادَ” (*kaad*), “كَوَدَ” (*kawid*): he came close to doing someone’s work.

“كَادَ يَفْعَلُ” (*kaada yaf’al*): he was close to doing it, or he was about to do it, i.e. he was about to do so but did not do it or stopped from doing it {T, M}.

“كَادَ زَيْدٌ يَفْعَلُ” (*kaada zaidun yaf’al*): Zaid was close to doing it but he did not do it.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:74	If we did not keep you steadfast, it was possible that you would have leaned a little, but you did not.	لَوْلَا أَنْ تَبَيَّنَّاكَ لَعَدَّ كَيْدٌ تَرَكُنُ إِلَيْهِمْ شَيْءًا قَلِيلًا
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This word also means “to intend”:

17:76	They had decided that they will uproot you, (weaken your stand) and send you in exile.	وَإِنْ كَادُوا لَيَسْتَفْرِزُّوكَ مِنَ الْأَرْضِ لِيُخْرِجُوكَ مِنْهَا
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Surah *Taha* says that when Allah ordered *Moosa* to go towards Pharaoh and to rise against him he said:

20:15	Indeed, the hour is coming. I have delayed it a bit (or kept it secret so far) so every soul shall be recompensed what it strives for	إِنَّ السَّاعَةَ آتِيَةٌ أَكَادُ أُخْفِيهَا لِيُخْرِجَ كُلُّ نَفْسٍ بِمَا تَسْعَى
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Here the part “أَكَادُ أُخْفِيهَا” (*aakadu ukhfihaa*) is notable. Going by the ordinary meaning of “كَادَ” (*kaada*), this verse would mean “I wanted to keep it secret but it could not be done”. But obviously, the reference is to Allah Himself, this cannot be the correct meaning of this verse.

It would therefore mean that the time of the manifestation of the results has been so preserved by Allah that ordinary folk or man cannot know when it will occur. But those people who employ their knowledge and insight can guess the imminent moment. Also according to the Law of Requit change in the world

and a society give early indications if facts are analysed in the light of the Quran about the type of events to come in the future.

”أَكَاذُ أَخْفِيهَا“ (*akaadu ukhfihaa*): that we have kept hidden as well as evident.

K-W-R

ك و ر

”تَكْرِيرُ الْعِمَامَةِ“ (*kaur-ul-imaama*): to wrap up the head gear or turban. It is also called ”تَكْرِيرُ الْعِمَامَةِ“ (*takreer-ul-imaama*).

This verb is also used to mean to lift or makeover powering.

”اِكْتَارَ الرَّجُلُ“ (*iktara rajul*): the man tied the turban.

”الْمِكْوَارُ“ (*al-mikuwar*): a turban

”الْكُورُ“ (*al-kaur*): one turn of the turban {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to turn (around) and congregate.

”كَوَّرَهُ تَكْوِيرًا“ (*kavvarahu takveera*): to spread-eagle.

”كَوَّرَ الرَّجُلُ تَكْوِيرًا“ (*kavvarar rajul takveera*): he threw the man down.

”كَوَّرْتُهُ فَتَكْوَرُ“ (*kavvartuhu fatakavvar*): I threw him down so he fell {T}.

The Quran says:

36:5	He makes the night overlap the day and the day overlap the night.	يَكْوُرُ اللَّيْلُ عَلَى النَّهَارِ وَيَكْوُرُ النَّهَارُ عَلَى اللَّيْلِ
81:1	When the sun will be wrapped up (or will be taken down)	إِذَا الشَّمْسُ كُوِّرَتْ

Both meanings are the same, i.e. the end of the *Persian* Empire at the hands of the *Muslims*. The flag of *Persia* was embedded with a sign of the sun, and hence the wrapping of this flag would mean the downfall of *Persia*. See heading (*Sh-M-S*). If the actual sun is taken to be meant here, then this verse signifies some universal change in the future.

K-W-K-B

ك و ك ب

”الْكَوْكَبُ“ (*al-kaukab*): star. The plural is ”كَوَاكِبُ“ (*kawakib*).

Raghib says it means a star which shines and is evident as in (6:77) {R}.

Figuratively it is used to mean a number of things. For example:

- dust that falls into eyes,
- tall trees,
- head of a nation,
- a rider,
- intensity of heat,
- sword,
- water,
- armed man,
- or spring of a well {T}.

”الْكَوْكَبَةُ“ (*al-kaukabah*): party {M}.

“كَانَ” (*kaan*) means the following:

1) “Is”:

33:51	Allah knows all and is the Judge.	كَانَ اللَّهُ عَلِيمًا حَكِيمًا
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2) “Was”:

16:120	Verily Ibrahim was not merely an individual but an entire faithful nation in him.	إِنَّ إِبْرَاهِيمَ كَانَ أُمَّةً قَانِتًا لِلَّهِ
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3) “Will be”:

76:6	Whose evil will be (or is) contagious.	كَانَ شَرُّهُ مُسْتَطِيرًا
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4) “Happened” or ‘was done’:

2:34	He denied, became rebellious, and thus became one of the deniers or those who do not accept.	أَبَىٰ وَاسْتَكْبَرَ ۖ كَانَ مِنَ الْكَافِرِينَ
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5) “Befitting”:

3:78	It is not befitting a man that God grants him government and messenger-hood and he...	مَا كَانَ لِيُشِيرَ أَنْ يُؤْتِيَهُ اللَّهُ الْكِتَابَ---
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6) “Stress”:

26:113	I do not know what they do	وَمَا عَلَّمِي بِمَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ
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7) Sometime redundant:

26:113	I do not know what they do	وَمَا عَلَّمِي بِمَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ
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Only *bima tamilun* would also have this same meaning, but if this verse is taken to mean whatever they have been doing, then *kaanu* is not redundant.

“كُنْ” (*kun*):

2:228	If she had faith in Allah	إِنْ كُنَّ يُؤْمِنُ بِاللَّهِ
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“أَكْ” (*aku*):

19:20	I am not a law breaker	وَلَمْ أَكْ بَعِيًّا
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The *nuun* has fallen out here. Actually it was “اَكُنْ” (*akun*) earlier.

“تَكْ” (*tak*):

11:109	do not be in doubt	فَلَا تَكُ فِي مَرْنَةٍ
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It was actually *takun* but the *nuun* has dropped out.

“يُكْ” (*yuk*):

8:53	He doesn't change the benevolence	لَمْ يَكُ مُعَيَّرًا
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It was earlier *yakun* but the *nuun* has fallen out.

“نَكْ” (*nak*):

74:43	We were not <i>musalleen</i>	لَمْ نَكُ مِنَ الْمُصَلِّينَ
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“كَانَ” (*kaana*): for something to be born or created or formed, or to happen.

“كَوْنٌ” (*kaun*): something which takes place suddenly, but if something is born or happens gradually then it is called “حَرَكَتٌ” (*harkat*) or movement.

Some say “كَوْنٌ” (*kaun*) means for something to take material shape.

Raghib says “كَوْنٌ” (*kaun*) is used when a thing changes its element for a higher element. But if it devolves into a lower element it is called “فَسَادٌ” (*fasaad*).

“كَوْنُ اللَّهِ الْأَشْيَاءُ” (*kaunal-laahul ashya*): Allah created things.

“الْكَائِنَةُ” (*al-ka'inah*): accident, event, that is, to come into being suddenly {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to inform about some event, whether in the past or present.

The Quran says:

2:117	God brought this universe from nothing into existence	بَدِيعَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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That is “إِبْدَاعٌ” (*ibdaah*) means to invent something or to bring something into existence for the very first time. How did this happen? It is related in the next verse:

2:117	when he decides about something, He says <i>kun</i> , so that <i>amr</i> or matter takes place or forms	وَإِذَا قَضَىٰ أَمْرًا فَإِنَّمَا يَقُولُ لَهُ كُنْ فَيَكُونُ
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“أَمْرٌ” (*amr*) is the state when things have not taken on a physical form. When a particular *amr* formulates according to Allah’s Will then it takes shape. We cannot even conceive of a thing without its form. Allah gives form to the formless things. We do not know anything about the world of *amr*, because it does not have a form. Allah gives form to a thing (55:24). That is why he has been called “الْمُصَوِّرُ” (*al-musawwir*) or the artist. How a thing comes into existence cannot be comprehended by us. All this takes place according to the law which Allah has created for the formulation of things.

“الْمَكَانُ” (*al-makaan*): site, place.

“الْإِسْتِكَاانَةُ” (*al-istakaana*): to be very sincere {T}, or to express helplessness. Some think that this word has come from “سَكَنَ” (*sakan*). That is why we have given its meaning under heading (S-K-N) as well.

“الْمُكَائِنَةُ” (*al-mukawanah*): battle and warfare {T}.

K-W-Y

ک و ی

“كَوَاهُ” (*kawahu*), “يَكْوِيهِ” (*yakvihi*), “كَيَّأُ” (*kayya*): branded him with a hot iron etc.

“الْمِكْوَاهُ” (*al-mikwah*): branding instrument {T}.

Ibn Faris says while the word has these meanings it also means he stared at him.

The Quran says that those who amass wealth (and do not keep it available for human kind will be heated in the fire of *jahannam* (9:35) and their sides and foreheads will be branded with it (as the criminals in those days were branded), so that they can be recognized from afar and people can avoid them and be safe from their criminal activity. According to the Quran, capitalism is a crime and one who amasses wealth, is a big criminal.

“کَی” (*kai*): is used to express reason. That is to mean ‘so that’.

59:7	So that wealth does not keep circulating among the wealthy only.	کَی لَا یَکُونُ دَوْلَةً بَيْنَ الْأَغْنِيَاءِ مِنْكُمْ
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“لَکَیْلَا” (*li kaila*): “لَ + کَی + لَا” (*li+kai+la*): so it may not happen like that.

“کَیْدُ” (*kaid*): reason or excuse and technique {*T*}.

Muheet says it means to harm someone secretly {*T, M*}.

This word is also used to mean struggle and strife. Some scholars have said that “کَیْدُ” (*kaid*) and “مَکْرُ” (*makr*) are of the same meaning. Others think that “کَیْدُ” (*kaid*) mean to harm and “مَکْرُ” (*makr*) means secret scheming and harming. Still others think that “کَیْدُ” (*kaid*) means to secretly apprehend, but it is not necessary that the subject discloses to the object what he wants. In “مَکْرُ” (*makr*) this condition is necessary {*T*}, but still this is not the rule.

Raghib thinks that “کَیْدُ” (*kaid*) means a sort of excuse and trick which can be used in a good as well as a bad behaviour, but is often used to mean bad {*R*}.

“کَادَا” (*kaada*): to intend, as well as to do battle {*T*}.

“کَیْدُ” (*kaid*) also means to plan secretly or openly against the enemy.

The Quran says:

3:19	Their scheming and plans will not hurt you	لَا يَضُرُّكُمْ كَيْدُ هُمْ شَيْئًا
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The gimmickry of the sorcerers of the Pharaoh’s court has also been called “کَیْدُ” (*kaid*):

20:69	Whatever they had created was gimmickry or deception only	إِنَّمَا صَنَعُوا كَيْدًا سَاحِرٍ
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Surah *Yusuf* says that the governor of *Egypt* said to his wife:

12:28	This is merely your conspiracy, and the conspiracies of women run deep.	إِنَّهُ مِنْ كَيْدِ كُرٍّ - إِنَّ كَيْدَ كُرٍّ عَظِيمٌ
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God has called his own planning as “کَیْدُ” (*kaid*):

86:15	They are also planning and so am I	إِنَّهُمْ يَكِيدُونَ كَيْدًا وَ كَيْدُ كَيْدًا
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Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:76	Thus we created a nice plan in which <i>Yusuf</i> was the gainer. (it was according to his wishes)	كَذَلِكَ كَيْدَنَا لِيُؤْسَفَ
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Surah *Al-ambia* says that *Ibrahim* told his nation:

21:87	By Allah, I will certainly work out a plan to harm your idols	وَتَاللَّهِ لَا كَيْدَ لَنَا أَصْنَا مِنْكُمْ
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Surah *At-toor* says “مَكِيدُونَ” (*makidoon*) in (52:42) to signify those who are prone to a conspiracy.

“كَيْفَ” (*kaifa*): “how”, or “in what meaning”.

“كَيْفَ تَكْفُرُونَ بِاللَّهِ” (*kaifa takfaroona billaah*): how can you deny Allah? (2:28)

“كَيْفَ فَعَلَ رَبُّكَ” (*kaifa fa’ala rabbuk*): how did your Sustainer do this? How did he deal with them? (105:1).

K-Y-L

ک ی ل

“كَالَ الطَّعَامِ” (*kaalat tuaam*), “يَكِيلُهُ” (*yakeeluhu*), “كَيْلًا” (*kaila*): measured the grain {T}.

“إِذَا كَالُواهُمْ” (*iza kaaluhum*): when they measure it and give them.

“اِكْتَالًا” (*iktaal’asla*): to take from someone by measuring (83:2).

Taj says that “كَالَ” (*kaal*), “اِكْتَالًا” (*iktaal*) have similar meanings, but the difference is that “كَالَ” (*kaal*) is used when you measure something yourself and give to somebody, “اِكْتَالًا” (*iktaal*) is used when you measure something to keep it for yourself {T}.

Raghib says “كَالَتْ لَهُ الطَّعَامَ” (*kiltu lahut tuaam*) means “I measured the grain for him”, and “كَالَتْ الطَّعَامَ” (*kiltuhut tuaam*) means “I weighed the grain and gave it to him”.

“اِكْتَالَتْ عَلَيْهِ” (*iktaltu alaih*): I took it from him after weighing {R}. *Ibn Faris* supports this opinion.

“كَيْلًا” (*kail*), “مِكْيَالًا” (*Mikyaal*): the measure with which the crop or grain etc. is weighed (6:153). The crop which is weighed is also called as referred in (12:59).

“كَيْلَ بَعِيرٍ” (*kaila ba-eer*): grain, or the weight of a camel, or weight which a camel can carry (12:65).

The Quran stresses that “لَا تَنْفُسُوا الْمِكْيَالَ وَالْمِيزَانَ” (*la tunqisul mikyaala wal-meezaan*) in (11:83).

Although it literally means “do not cheat in weighing”, but it can mean as a social rule too. It means to establish a social justice in which everyone’s rights are given so that none draws more than required and none retains more than required. This rule will finish the capitalism.

If a factory owner or landowner gives everything to the worker which he produces, then nothing is left for himself. This is what the Quran intends, i.e. the remuneration will be for the labour and not the return for the capital. Those who keep something back from the labourers are *mukhsireen* (26:181).

LUGHAT-UL-QURAN

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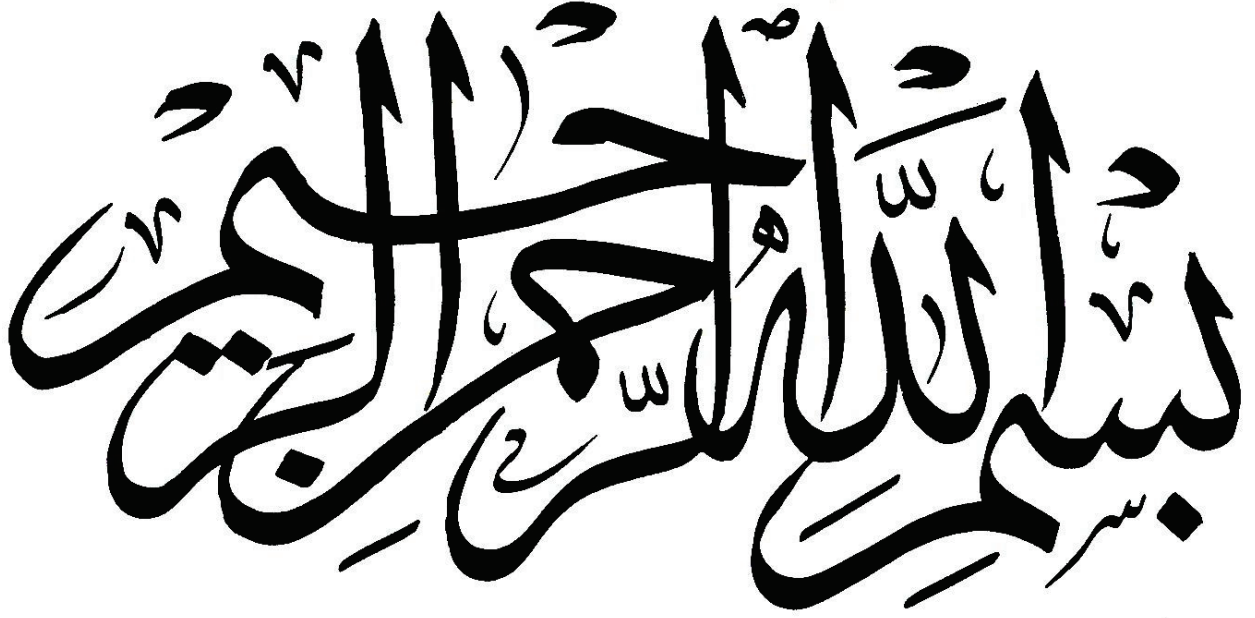
VOLUME IV

Ebook edition

Originally compiled in Urdu by
Allama Ghulam Ahmad Parwez

Edited/Translated by:
Sheraz Akhtar - Quranic Education Society Norway

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Translator and editor: Sheraz Akhtar

Published by: Quranic Education Society, Oslo - Norway

In association with Tolu-e-Islam Trust, Lahore - Pakistan

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“ل” (*la*) or “لي” (*li*) are used to mean the following:

1) To express one’s right:

“الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ” (*al-hamdu-lillaah*): only Allah has the right to be admired and praised (for His Attributes).

2) To be particular to someone:

“وَلَهُمْ مَا يَشْتَهُونَ” (*walahum ma yastahoon*): they specially want things that they like (16:58).

3) To express possession:

“لَهُ مَا فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*lahu ma fis samawati fil ard*): whatever there is in the highs and the lows of the universe belongs to Him. (1:33).

4) To express benefit or gain:

“وَإِنَّا لَنَافِلُ الْحَدِيدِ” (*wa alannalahul hadeed*): We made iron soft for him so that he could benefit from it (34:10).

5) To express reason: (in the meaning of ‘so that’):

“وَإِنَّا لَنَزَّلْنَا إِلَيْكَ الذِّكْرَ لِتُبَيِّنَ لِلنَّاسِ” (*wa anzalna ilaikaz zikra li tubayyinal linnaas*): and we have revealed this Quran unto you so that you disclose it for the benefit of mankind (16:44).

6) To stress the negative:

“مَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيُظْلِعَكُمْ عَلَى الْغَيْبِ” (*ma kaanal laahu li yutli-ukum ala ghaib*): Allah does not inform you at all about ‘*ghaib*’ or unseen (3:178).

7) To mean towards as “*ila*”:

“بِأَنَّ رَبَّكَ أَوْحَىٰ لَهَا” (*bi anna rabbaka au ha laha*): because your Sustainer has sent him the revelation (99:5).

8) To mean “up to”:

“كُلُّ يَجْرِى لِأَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى” (*kullun yajri li-ajalin musamma*): everything is moving as per a defined period (13:2).

“إِلَىٰ أَجَلٍ” (*ila ajalin*): for a fixed period (31:29).

8) To mean ‘above’ as “*ala*”:

“وَتَلَّ لِلْجَبِينِ” (*wa tallahu lil jabeen*): and for this purpose he made him lie face down (37:103).

“عَلَىٰ” (*ala*) is used when something goes against somebody, and “ل” (*la*) appears when it goes to his credit:

“لَهَا مَا كَسَبَتْ وَعَلَيْهَا مَا اكْتَسَبَتْ” (*as laha ma kasabat wa alaiha mak tasabat*): whoever does good deeds will benefit from them and whoever does bad deeds will reap the consequences (2:286).

9) Sometimes “ل” (*la*) also appears for “عَلَىٰ” (*ala*) or “on”:

“وَإِنْ أَصَاكُمْ فَلَهَا” (*wa inn asatum falaha*): if you indulge in bad things, then you will be the loser (17:7).

“وَلَهُمُ الْعَذَابُ وَلَهُمْ سُوءُ الدَّارِ” (*walahumul la’natu walahum su-ud daar*): for them is deprivation-and as a consequence there is very a bad abode for them (40:52).

10) To mean “في” (*fi*) or “in”:

“وَنَضَعُ الْمَوَازِينَ الْقِسْطَ لِيَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ” (*wa naza-ul mawazeenal qista li yaumil qiyamah*): and on the day of the *qiyamat* We will set up scales of justice (21:47).

11) To mean “عِنْدَ” (*ind*): as “to some”:

“إِقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ لِذُلُوكِ الشَّمْسِ إِلَىٰ عَسْقِ اللَّيْلِ” (*aqimis sallata li dulukis shams-i ila ghasaqil lail*): (17:78).

“لِدُلُوكِ الشَّمْسِ” (*li dulukis shams-i*): near *dulukis shams* or after the *dulukis shams*.

“لَ” (*la*) often comes to mean from. Therefore this verse could mean from “*dulukis shamsi*” to “*ghasaqil laif*” i.e. from the Sun’s decline to the darkness of the night.

12) To highlight the subject:

“لَا تَقُولُوا لِمَنْ يُقْتَلُ” (*la taqulu liman yuqtal*): do not say of those who are killed (2:154).

13) To lay stress:

“لَعَمْرُكَ إِنَّهُمْ لَفِي سَكْرَتِهِمْ يَعْمَهُونَ” (*la-umruka innahum lafi sakratihim ya'mahoon*): swear upon your age that they were being blind in their drunken-ness or stupor (15:72). See heading (*Ain-M-R*).

“نَبِّزْ فَوْرَ رَبِّكَ لَنَعْتَرَهُنَّ” (*faura rabbika lanah shoran nahum*): Swear upon your Sustainer “We will certainly gather them together and bring them” (19:68).

14) Sometimes it is additional e.g.:

“هَٰئِهِتَ هَٰئِهِتَ لِمَا تُوْعَدُونَ” (*haihaata haihaata lima tu'adoon*) (23:36). Here “مَاتُوا عُدُونَ” (*ma tu'adoon*) also has the same meaning.

15) Sometimes it is used to begin a sentence (to mean ‘that’):

“إِذْ قَالُوا لِيُوسُفُ وَأَخُوهُ” (*iz qaalu li Yusuf wa akhu hu...*): when they said Yusuf and his brother.... (12:8).

16) Sometime it is used to mean ‘certainly’ or for laying stress:

“لَمَسْجِدٍ أُسِّسَ عَلَى التَّقْوَىٰ” (*la masjidun ussisa alat taqwa*): certainly the mosque which has been based on *taqwa* i.e. *righteousness* (9:108).

La لا

“لا” (*la*) expressed negative command.

“لَا تَضْرِبْ” (*la tazrib*): do not hit.

It also comes to mean the following:

1) To mean negative:

2:2	there is no doubt about it	لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ
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2) To mean “لَيْسَ” (*laisa*) or ‘no’:

10:61	Neither bigger than this nor smaller. They are all in a clear book	لَا أَصْغَرَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ وَلَا كَبَرَ إِلَّا فِي كِتَابٍ مُبِينٍ
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3) “لَا جَرَمَ” (*la jaram*) is used as a proverb or saying and means “the truth is”, or “the fact is” (16:23).

4) Sometimes it appears as if someone is being replied to

90:11	I present this city as evidence	لَا أَقْسِمُ بِحَذِّ الْبَلَدِ
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5) Sometimes it is redundant:

7:12	when I had ordered you what kept you from genuflecting or performing the bowing	مَا مَنَعَكَ آلَا تَسْجُدَ إِذْ أَمَرْتُكَ
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If here “لا” (*la*) is not used then too the meaning will remain the same, as in (38:75).

Allat اللَّاتُ

“اللَّاتُ” (*allaat*): it was the name of an idol in *Ta-if* for the tribe of *Taqeef* in days before the advent of the Quran. It is feminine and therefore the idol it represents was most likely seen as a goddess (53:19).

Laat لَات

This word is used to mean “no”. The Quran says:

38:3	And when there was no more time left to escape	وَلَا تَحِثُّ مَنَاصٍ
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Some say that in “لَات” (*laat*) the “لَا” (*la*) is to mean ‘no’ and “تَ” (*ta*) is redundant. But this redundant appears only with “حِثُّ” (*heena*). Some think that it is “نَقَصَ” (*naqasa*) and has been made into “لَات” (*laat*). Some say that it is a permanent word and means “no”.

L-A-L-A ل أ ل أ

“لَا لَاتِ الْمَرْءُ أَهٌ بِعَيْنَيْهَا” (*la’a la’a til mar’atah bi ainaiha*): the woman brightened her eyes, made eyes.
 “لَا لَاتِ النَّارُ” (*la’a la’a tin naar*): the fire flared up and became illuminated {*T,R,M*}.
 “لُؤْلُؤُ” (*al-lu lu’u*): with plural “لَا لِيءَ” (*laali*) means “pearl”, because pearls are shiny {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says basically it means to be shiny.

Surah *Al-Hajj* mentions “لُؤْلُؤُ” (*lu lu’u*) as one of the things of adornment of *jannat* (22:23).

It means golden bangles, pearl, silky dress, i.e. all accoutrements of a luxurious life. Hence (22:23) resembles *jannat* to a society in which all things that signify power, luxury and comfort are present and are to be distributed and used according to the laws of Allah.

Li-alla لِئَلَّا

“لِئَلَّا” (*li-alla*): lest it so happens, so that no...

57:29	so those with the Book know that...	لَقَدْ يَعْلَمُ أَهْلُ الْكِتَابِ
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Here “لِ” (*laam*) is redundant.

L-B-B ل ب ب

“أَلَبَّ عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*al-abba ala al-amr*): remained steadfast on something and did not give it up.
 “رَجُلٌ لَبٌّ” (*rajulun labb*): a man who continues to be engaged in his work and does not give up.
 “أَلَلَبُّ” (*al-lab*): to be steadfast on something.
 “أَلَبَّ بِالْمَكَانِ” (*allabba bilmakaan*): he stayed at so and so place {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to remain collected and to be with, as well as to be pure and pleasant.

“لَبَّيْكَ” (*labbaika*): I consider being faithful to you as mandatory for me. I owe allegiance to you.

Some say that it is derived from “ذَارِي تَلُبُّ دَارَهُ” (*daari talubbu daarah*), i.e. “my house is facing his”. Therefore “لَبَّيْكَ” (*labbaika*) means “my face is towards you” {T}.

“لُبُّ” (*lubb*): the pure part of anything, or the kernel.

“لَبَّ اللُّوزَ” (*lubb al lauz*): he broke an almond (shell) and took out its kernel {T}.

“اللَّبَّ” (*al-labb*): part of the chest on which a necklace is worn {T}.

“اللُّبُّ” (*al-lubb*): intellect. The plural is “الْبَابُ” (*al-baab*).

Muheet says that this word is derived from the Syrian word “لَبُو” (*libu*) or Hebrew word “لֵב” (*lib*) which mean “the heart”. In Arabic the heart is called “اللُّبُّ” (*al-lub*) because it is covered (like an almond - kernel within a shell) with fat.

Raghib says that “لُبُّ” (*lubb*) means sharp intellect which is pure and free from any adulteration, i.e. which is free of emotions, which is not subservient to emotions.

The Quran says:

3:189	for men of understanding	أُولَى الْأَلْبَابِ
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These are people who do not make the intellect subservient to their emotions and make their mind t work in the light of the revelation. Thus their intellect is used for the good of others. The selfish intellect shows man the way of attaining personal gains, and the intellect directed by the guidance of the revelation shows him the way to universal nourishment and development i.e. for the good of mankind (13:17). That is why the Quran has said after “أُولَى الْأَلْبَابِ” (*oolil albaab*) i.e. “لَذِينَ يَذْكُرُونَ اللَّهَ” (*allazeena yazkurunallah*) in (3:189-190), i.e. “those intelligent people who keep the revelation in their mind all the time”.

A **momin's** duty is to employ the intellect in the light of the revelation. If any of these things are missing then he cannot be called a **momin**.

L-B-Th

ل ب ث

“لَبَّ” (*labisa*), “يَلْبَسُ” (*yalbisu*), “لَبَسَ” (*labsan*), “لَبْسًا” (*lubsaa*), “لَبَّاسًا” (*labasa*): to stay, to live, to stop, to delay or to wait.

“الْتَلَبَّ” (*at-talabbusu*): to wait a moment, or to stay (33:14) {T}.

“لَبَّ بِالْمَكَانِ” (*labisa bilmakaan*): stayed at some spot resolutely, or stayed there permanently {R}.

“لَبَّ” (*libis*): someone who stays. The plural is “لَابِسُونَ” (*labison*) and “لَابِسِينَ” (*labisn*) as in (78:23).

The opponents used to ask the Messenger **Muhammed** for the proof of his messenger-hood. The Messenger repliend:

10:16	I have spent a lifetime (before the messenger-hood) among you. Can you not judge whether this sort of life is of a man who speaks truth or tells lies?	فَقَدْ لَبَّتُ فِيكُمْ عُمُرًا مِنْ قَبْلِهِ أَفَلَا تَعْقِلُونَ
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He said that “if you use your intellect and reasoning, then my life among you will be a proof of my being truthful and the nature of the revelation being a proof of my messenger-hood. I am not a stranger and you can well judge whether I am a liar or speak the truth”.

Note how great is this claim which the Messenger has used in support of his being a truthful individual. The proof of a truthful individual is that he can claim not among his friends but among his opponents that his previous righteous life is a proof of his honesty and truthfulness.

“لَبَدَ بِالْمَكَانِ” (*labada bilmakaan*): to stay somewhere and stick to that place.
 “لَبْدٌ” (*libd*): in which wool is stuffed.
 “مَالٌ لُبْدٌ” (*maalun lubd*): abundant wealth, or large accumulated wealth {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means for something to be collected on top of another.

The Quran says:

90:6	I wasted a lot of the collected wealth	أَهْلَكْتُ مَالًا لُبَدًا
72:19	they pounced on him as a crowd	النَّاسُ لُبْدٌ

“يَكُونُونَ عَلَيْهِ لِبْدًا” (*annaasu lubad*): people gathered.
 “لَبْدُ الْقَوْمِ بِالرَّجُلِ” (*labidal qaumu bir rajul*): people surrounded him and did not leave him {T}.

“لَبَسَ” (*labas*), “يَلْبَسُ” (*yalbis*), “لَبْسًا” (*labsa*): to fuse things so that one thing cannot be distinguished from another. It also means to create doubt {T}. Hence it also means to hide one thing into another.

2:42	Do not confuse the truth by mixing it with falsehood	وَلَا تَلْبِسُوا الْحَقَّ بِالْبَاطِلِ
6:9	the doubt in which they have thrown themselves	وَلَكَبَسْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ مَا يَلْبِسُونَ

“لَبَسَ” (*labisa*), “يَلْبَسُ” (*yabasu*), “لَبْسًا” (*lubsa*): to wear.
 “الْلَبْسُ” (*al-lubus*), “الْلَبَاسُ” (*al-libaas*): that which is worn {T}.
 “الْلَبَاسُ” (*al-libaas*): husband or wife {T}.

The Quran says:

2:187	husband and wife are each other's dressing	هُنَّ لِبَاسٌ لَكُمْ وَأَنْتُمْ لِبَاسٌ لَهُنَّ
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It means that they have nothing in between and are dependent upon each other.

“الْلَبُوسُ” (*al-lalaboos*): the armour and weapon {T}. The Quran has said “صَنْعَةَ لَبُوسٍ” (*san'atah labus*) in (21:80) which means “to make armour”.
 “لَبَسَ فُلَانٌ امْرَأَةً” (*labisa fulanun imra'ah*): that man enjoyed that woman for a period (had sexual relations with her) {M}.
 “أَمْرٌ مُلْبِسٌ” (*amrun mulbis*), “مُلْتَبِسٌ” (*multabis*): doubtful matter {T}.
 “التَّلْبِيسُ” (*at-talbees*): to hide the reality and to make things appear as opposed to reality.

50:15	These people are doubtful about being raised again (they are confused in this matter)	بَلْ هُمْ فِي لَبْسٍ مِنْ خَلْقٍ جَدِيدٍ
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The Quran expostulate everything clearly so that nothing remains ambiguous. There is no ambiguity in it, and everything is made clear. It thinks that hiding a fact or mixing reality with falsehood is a crime (2:42). Therefore there is no question of truth compromising with falsehood. These two cannot even meet, leave alone falsehood hiding the truth. Mixing truth with falsehood means to make those matters a part of the revelation which are not revealed in the Quran. This is a serious issue as this will never produce the good results which the Quran promises to those who follow the guidance. The Muslims who claim the Quran to be the book of Allah are not benefitting from the guidance as a consequence of this practice of mixing it with the non-Quranic injunctions. The Quran deals with the issues of the human thought process and its decision making is affected if its permanent values are not followed as directed. This what the Quran means when it says do not associate anyone else with Him (18:26).

L-B-N

ل ب ن

“الْلَبْنُ” (*al-lalban*): milk {T}.

“الْلَبِينُ” (*al-lalbin*): the blocks (or bricks) with which a building is constructed.

The Quran says:

16:66	milk which is delightful for those who drink	لَبَنًا خَالِصًا سَاءَ غَاً لِلشَّارِبِينَ
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L-J-A

ل ج ا

“الْتَجَاوُ” (*laja'a*), “الْتَجَا إِلَيْهِ” (*altaja'a ilaih*): he sought sanctuary with him.

“الْجَاهُ إِلَى كَذَا” (*aliaahu ila kaza*): forced him to it.

“الْجَافِلَانَا” (*al-ja'a fulana*): he saved him, or took him into protection {T, M}.

“تَلَجَّأَ مِنْهُمْ” (*talajja minhum*): he separated himself from them and their group and leaned towards others {T}.

“الْمَلْجَا” (*al-laja'u*), “الْمَلْجَا” (*al-malja'u*): sanctuary or a place to be safe and to be protected {T} (9:57).

L-J-J

ل ج ج

“الْلُجْ” (*al-lujju w*), “الْلُجَّةُ” (*al-lujjah*): deep waters.

“لُجَّ الْبَحْرِ” (*lujj ul-bahr*): the deep spot in a river from where the river banks are not visible.

“بَحْرُ لُجَّجٍ” (*bahrul lujaaj*): vast, wide river.

“الْلُجَّاجُ” (*al-lajaaj*): to continue and increase the quarrel even though one's fault has been ascertained, or to insist in a quarrel, or continue to oppose {T, M}. For this, “لَجَّ فِي الْأَمْرِ” (*lajja fil amr*) has been used.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is to return to its elements, time and time again.

“الْلُجَّاجُ” (*al-lajaaj*): to insist.

“لُجَّ الْبَحْرِ” (*lujjul bahr*): a big part of a sea because the elements of this sea keep on being overturned.

“لُجَّةٌ” (*lujjah*) means to keep coming and to keep turning over {R}.

“لُجَّةُ الْبَحْرِ” (*lujjatul bahr*): waves of the sea which keep on coming and returning {R}.

“لُجَّاجٌ” (*lajaaj*): not to abstain from a deed and to continue to do it {R}.

The Quran says:

67:21	they keep on progressing in their hatred and rebelliousness	بَلْ جَحُّوا فِي عُتُوٍّ وَ نُفُورٍ
27:24	he thought it to be deep waters	حَسِبْتُهُ لُجَّةً
24:40	deep and vast sea	بَحْرٍ بَهِيمٍ

L-H-D

ل ح د

According to **Ibn Faris**, the root basically means to move away from the centre to one side.

“الْلَحْدُ” (*allahd*): the hole that is dug width wise beside a grave which the dead are buried in.

“صَرْيَحٌ” (*zarreehun*) is the hole which is dug in the middle.

“لَحَدَ إِلَيْهِ” (*lahada ilaih*): he leaned or bent towards him {T}. The same meaning is of “إِلْتَحَدَ إِلَيْهِ” (*iltahada ilaih*) {R}.

“أَلْحَدَ” (*alhaad*): he turned away from the right *Deen*.

“إِلْحَادُ” (*al-ilhaad*): to turn away, return, or to give up the balanced path and lean towards oppression and wrong {T}.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:180	those who turn away from Allah and bend to one side	الَّذِينَ يُلْحِدُونَ فِي أَسْمَائِهِ
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For example the Christians have a belief which associates blank mercy to God and have ignored the law of requital and its consequences. It is a deliberate diversion in *Deen* as revealed in the Quran (4:171).

The Quran says:

41:40	People who practice <i>ilhaad</i> in teh revelation (give up the balanced path and move to one side)	الَّذِينَ يُلْحِدُونَ فِي آيَاتِنَا
22:25	Whoever display rebelliousness and oppression, and turn away from the righteous path and use <i>kaabah</i> for wrong purposes	وَمَنْ يُرِدْ فِيهِ بِالْحَادِ بِظُلْمٍ
16:103	Language of the one they refer to	لِسَانُ الَّذِينَ يُلْحِدُونَ

In (16:103) “إِلْحَادُ” (*ilhaad*) means to attribute something wrongly, that is, to move away from the path and to attribute.

“مُلْتَحَدًا” (*multahada*): sanctuary towards which one goes for protection (by shunning his usual way) (18:27). It also means an underground pass or tunnel.

The above verse of Surah *Al-Airaaf* unveils a great truth. The complete verse says:

7:180	All attributes of Allah are duly balanced and proportionate. So call Him with reference to those attributes and leave those who turn away from Him. They will soon be recompensed for what they do	وَلِلَّهِ الْأَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَىٰ فَادْعُوهُ بِهَا - وَذُرُوا الَّذِينَ يُلْحِدُونَ فِي أَسْمَائِهِ - سَيُجْزَوْنَ مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ
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The Quran refers to the attributes of Allah in detail and thus defines Him as a model for each one of us for guidance. Each of these attributes which are applicable to us is infinitely balanced and proportionate and when accepted and followed gradually helps us in the self-development. The permanent values given in the Quran define the boundaries within which we live our life and work towards attaining these attributes with a view to establish a system for the good of mankind. Those who acknowledge those attributes but do not maintain proportion in them are “مُلْحِدٌ” (*mulhid*). You must have nothing to do with them. The result of their erroneous ways will soon be before them, so do not follow them.

Note that “مُلْحِدٌ” (*mulhid*) is not one who denies the existence of God or His attributes, but someone who upsets the balance in any of those attributes by going against them. This is a wrong way. Islam means to maintain the balance as explained in the Quran whether it is within the values or the attributes.

L-H-F

ل ح ف

“الْلِّحَافُ” (*al-lihaaf*): the clothes that we put over us to ward off the cold in winter or which we wrap around ourselves to keep warm. It can be used for a blanket, quilt, etc. which are put over all those clothes which we are already wearing {T}.

Ibn Faris says this root basically means to wrap, to stick to, or to be with.

“لَحَفَهُ” (*lahafah*): he put the blanket over him.

“إِلْتَحَفَ بِهِ” (*iltahafa bihi*): he wrapped it around himself {T}.

Surah *Al-Bagrah* says:

2:273	they do not pester someone while asking	لَا يَسْتَعْجِلُونَ النَّاسَ إِنْ حَافُوا
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Figuratively it means to do something with great exaggeration or intensity of force **{R}**.

“لَحَقَهُ” (*lahiqah*), “يُلْحَقُهُ” (*yalhaquh*), “الْحَقَّةُ” (*alhaqah*), “الْحَاقَّةُ” (*ilhaaqa*): to get something, to meet with it.
 “الْحَقَّةُ بِهِ” (*alhaqahu bihi*): made him follow him or made them meet each other.
 “الْمُلْحِقُ” (*al-mulhiq*): the man who leaves his own clan and joins another. Therefore, it means to meet or join somebody.
 “تَلَاَحَقَتِ الرِّكَابُ” (*tala haqatir rikaab*): the transports went on joining each other {*T, R, M*}.

Surah *Al-Yusuf* contains this prayer of *Yusuf*:

12:101	make me meet the <i>saliheen</i> (those who do good deeds) or make me one of the <i>saliheen</i>	وَاجْعَلْنِي بِالصَّالِحِينَ
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Surah *Al-Jumma* says about the Messenger *Muhammed* and nations which have so far not met him i.e. coming later in the future:

62:3	Because <i>Muhammed</i> is a messenger for all mankind	وَأَخْرَيْنَ مِنْهُمْ لَمَّا يَلْحَقُوا
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In other words, his messenger-hood for the coming generations is the same as it is for the generation he was born in. Therefore to believe that any other messenger will come after *Muhammad* is wrong and totally against the Quranic teachings i.e. the revelation is completed and there is no need for a further revelation from Allah – this becomes evident when we study the Quran as directed and explained within it.

Ibn Faris says it means for one thing to enter another.

“لُحْمَةٌ” (*luhmah*): closeness, relationship, or the weft of the cloth which along with the waft forms the cloth.
 “اللَّحْمُ” (*al-lahm*): meat, because its elements are intertwined with each other.
 “الْمُلْحَمَةُ” (*al-malhamah*): a fierce battle, or a big event of fratricide {*T, R, M*}.
 “لَحْمُ الْخِنْزِيرِ” (*lahm-ul-khinzeer*): flesh of pork (2:173).
 “الْلَّحِمُ” (*al-lahim*): the house where a lot of back biting is done {*T, R, M*}.

The Quran has likened back biting to eating a dead brother's flesh (49:12).

The plural of “لَحْمٌ” (*lahm*) is “لُحُومٌ” (*luhum*) as in (22:37).

“الْلَّحْنُ” (*al-lahn*) basically means to be detracted from the right path {*T, R, M*}

What it actually means is to change the context of a thing or way in which it is usually taken. One way of doing this is to fix secret meanings of words, and when those words are spoken, people take the usual meanings but those who know will take the designated secret meaning. Another way is to change the construction of the word. The third way is to change the meanings of the words or its connotation. A man who is very intelligent and comprehends the connotations is called “لَحِينٌ” (*lahin*) {*R*}.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings:

- To turn a thing away from its right path.
- Genius and intellect.

The Quran says about the hypocrites:

47:30	the way they twist the words gives them away	وَلَتَعْرِفَنَّهُمْ فِي لَحْنِ الْقَوْلِ
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About the Jews Surah *Al-Nisa* says:

4:46	(about the Jews) they say; ‘we hear and we disobey’, and ‘hear, you may not hear’ and with ‘Raina’, with a twist of their tongues...	يَقُولُونَ سَمِعْنَا وَعَصَيْنَا وَاسْمِعْ غَيْرَ مُسْمِعٍ وَارْعِنَا لَيْتَ بِالسَّيِّئِينَ
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“الْلَحْنُ” (*al-lahn*): also means language or dialect, and also to make mistakes while reading.

“لَا حِسْنَ” (*la-hisn*): someone who speaks wrongly.

“قَدْ لَحَنَ لَهُ لَحْنًا” (*qad lahana lahu lahna*): he spoke in such a way so that only he could understand him, i.e. through symbols and innuendos etc. {R}.

L-H-Y ل ح ي

Ibn Faris says “لَحَى” (*lahy*) has two basic meanings. One is “part of the body” or “the jaw” and the second meaning is “to pare something”.

“الْلَحَاءُ” (*al-lihaa*): bark of a tree.

“الْلَحْيَةُ” (*al-lihyah*): beard.

“الْلَحْيُ” (*allahyu*): jaw or the place where the beard grows.

“لَحَيْتُ فُلَانًا لَحَاءً” (*lahaitu fulanun alhaah*): I demeaned him, shamed him.

“لَا حٍ” (*laahin*): one who demeans:

“مُلْحِي” (*malhiyyun*): the man who is demeaned.

“لَا حَاءُ مَلَا حَاءً” (*lahaahu mula haatan*): he fought him, or they abused or demeaned each other:

The Quran says:

20:94	Do not hold my beard (do not insult me)	لَا تَأْخُذْ بِلِحْيَتِي
7:150	He caught his brother by the head and pulled him	وَأَخَذَ بِرَأْسِ أَخِيهِ يُخْرِجُهُ إِلَيْهِ

Here along with verbal condemnation, movement of the hands is also referred.

L-D-D ل د د

“الْلَدُّ” (*al-ladu*): a man whose intent is very firm and he cannot be turned away from his purpose. It signifies a man who is very adamant and quarrelsome and does not listen to anyone. Plural is “الْلُدُّ” (*ludd*).

“الْلَدِيدَانِ” (*al-ladeedaan*): both sides of the neck which are below the ears, or both ends of the valley {T}:

“الْلَدُّ” (*ludd*) would mean “removed from truth”. It is also used for those who do not listen to reason, or a quarrelsome man who is deaf in a way because he refuses to listen to what others have to say, but only keeps saying what he wants.

“الْتَدَّ عَنْهُ” (*iltudda unhu*): he moved away from it {R}.

“الْدُدْتُهٖ” (*al-dudtahu*): I found him very quarrelsome {R}.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings. One is “to quarrel” and second is “the edge of something”.

The Quran says:

2:204	he is very quarrelsome	هُوَ الَّذِي الْخَصَامُ
19:97	A hostile nation	قَوْمًا لَّدَا

“لَدُنْ” (*ladun*): near, or close by.

“مِنْ لَدُنْ” (*min ladun*): from.

“مِنْ لَدُنْ حَكِيمٍ خَبِيرٍ” (*min ladun hakeemin khabeer*): from God, the All-knowing (11:1).

“لَدَا الْبَابِ” (*ladal baab*): near the door (12:25).

In Sufism (mysticism) there is a term “*ilmi ludni*” which means “knowledge which a man gets directly from God”. ‘*kashf*’ or ‘*ilhaam*’ are also mentioned under heading (**L-M-H**). As mentioned therein, the concept of *ilhaam* and *kashf* after the end of the messenger-hood and the messenger **Muhammed** being the last messenger is non Quranic. Whatever knowledge required for guidance is in the Quran. Nobody can otherwise get any knowledge directly from Allah. Direct knowledge from God is called **Wahi** and after **Muhammed**, **Wahi** has stopped and there is no need as the Quran is a complete book of guidance for all times

“لَدَىٰ” (*lada*) appears to mean “لَدُنْ” (*ladun*):

40:18	(when hearts will come) up to the throats or near the throat.	لَدَى الْحَنَاجِرِ
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L-Dh-Dh

ل ذ ذ

“الَّذَّةُ” (*al-lazzah*): wish, or the pleasure which one likes. It is the opposite of “الْمُ” (*alum*).

“الَّذَّةُ” (*lazzah*), “الَّذِيمُ” (*lazzabihi*): he found it to be tasty {*M*}.

“وَتَلَذُّ الْأَعْيُنُ” (*wa talazzul ain*): and pleasing to the eyes (43:71).

“الَّذَّةُ” (*al-lazzah*): tasty.

The Quran says:

37:46	pleasant or tasty for those who drink it	لَذَّةٍ لِلشَّارِبِينَ
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Muheet says to comprehend that something is tasty or pleasant to one's liking is also called “الَّذَّةُ” (*lazzah*).

L-Z-B

ل ز ب

“الزَّبُّ” (*lazbun*): for something to be stable, steadfast and to remain along with.

“الزَّابُ” (*laazib*): must {*F*}.

“اللزُّوبُ” (*al-luzub*): to stick to.

“طِينٌ لَزِيبٌ” (*teenil laazib*): sticky mud (37:11).

“اللزَّابُ” (*al-lalazib*): a thing which dries up with something, or sticks to it and solidifies with it.

“اللزَّابُ” (*lazibat tain*): the mud dried up and became hard.

“اللزَّابَةُ” (*al-lazbah*): severe draught which seems to have stuck, because days of misery do not go away very easily {*T, R*}.

About human creation it is said in Surah **Az-zaafaat** that man has been created from “طِينٌ لَزِيبٌ” (*teenin laazib*) in (37:11). It says that when water mixed with soil, it created the first form of life cells. Scientists believe today that small life cells were created along the edges of water filled ditches. Life has evolved from these life cells. For details, see the book titled **Iblees and Adam** under the heading **Insaan**.

“لَزِمَ” (*lazim*), “يَلْزِمُ” (*yalzam*), “لُزُومًا” (*luzuma*): for something to solidify, be permanent, to stick with and not be separated.

“الْمَلْزَمُ” (*al-milzam*): trap.

“الْمُلَازِمُ” (*al-mulaazim*): he who sticks to somebody. It also means one who embraces {T}.

“لَزِمَ الشَّيْءُ” (*lazimash shaiyi*): the thing was enduring or lasting.

“لَزِمَ الْمَالُ فُلَانًا” (*lazimal maalu fulana*): the money became incumbent upon that man {M}.

“لُزُومُ الشَّيْءِ” (*luzumush shaiyi*): for something to last long {M, T}.

“الْلِزَامُ” (*al-lizaam*): the thing which sticks and does not separate (25:77).

The Quran says that *Nooh* told his nation that the invitation to the guidance which has not clearly been made known to you:

11:28	Can I forcibly impose it upon you?	أَتُلْزِمُكُمْ مَعَهَا وَ أَنْتُمْ لَهَا كَارِهُونَ
28:26	He put them on <i>taqwa</i> (the path of righteousness)	وَأَلْزَمَهُمْ كَلِمَةَ التَّقْوَى

Surah *Al-Taha* says about the punishment from Allah:

20:129	it was one to come and stick to them	لَكَانَ لِرِزَامًا
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Ibn Faris says this root means a thing which is very long and fine but does not break.

“لِسانٌ” (*lisaan*) the plural of which is “اللسنة” (*al-sinah*) means language, tongue or the speaking power (14:4, 28:34) {T}

In Surah *Al-Maryam* it is said after the mention of the messengers:

16:50	put him in a place where the world respects him {T}	وَجَعَلْنَا لَهُمْ لِسَانَ صِدْقٍ عَلِيًّا
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Or it may mean that he always held the revealed truth high and presented this truth to the world.

The Quran has described the difference of languages as signs of Allah (30:22). The research on languages of the world has in our times acquired the form of a philosophy which in *Ernst Cassirer's* words is called “*The Philosophy of Symbolic Forms*” Also *Dr. Bucke* in his book “*The Cosmic Consciousness*” has analysed different languages and described the culture of different nations which reveals how the difference of languages are the signs of God.

It is only the beginning of this research: with the passage of time more research and evidence will come out which will put light on the truth about the Quranic verse (41:53).

“لَطَفَ” (*latafa*), “يَلْطَفُ” (*yaltaf*): to deal with somebody kindly or softly.

“اللطيف” (*latufa*), “يَلْطُفُ” (*yaltaf*): for something to be small and fine {T}.

“اللطيف” (*al-lateef*): it is one of the attributes of Allah. It could mean that He is aware of very minute details of everything; as well as providing guidance to man for which He resorts to a very fine stance as He knows the ‘secret of the hearts’ and that He is very kind and merciful in bestowing His guidance where required or where asked as per the Quran {R}.

Muheet says it means “very clear” {M}. For God to be *Lateef* also means that His law is so fine that it is imperceptible. A tree grows, it grows leaves, it bears fruit, and the sun revolves. There is a whole series of

changes that take place in the universe, where deeds are formulating their results. But all these changes are imperceptible. All this goes on in a very fine manner.

“اللطيف من الكلام” (*al-lateef minal kalaam*): very fine and difficult matter {T}.

“اللطائف” (*al-lata-if*): the things which human senses cannot grasp {T}.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:104	Human eyes cannot behold God, and he can see all because He is Lateef and All Knowing	لَا تُدْرِكُهُ الْأَبْصَارُ وَهُوَ يُدْرِكُ الْأَبْصَارَ وَهُوَ اللَّطِيفُ الْخَبِيرُ
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This means that He is viewer of fine details.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says that the fellowship of the cave said that one of us should go to the habitation and bring something to eat:

18:19	He should be careful lest someone comes to know about us	وَلَيْسَتَ لَطْفٌ وَلَا يُشْعِرَنَّ بِكُمْ أَحَدًا
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Meaning of “لطف” (*lutf*) is also evident here, i.e. to do something imperceptibly without getting noticed by others.

L-Ze-Y ل ظ ي

“اللاظي” (*al-laza*): fire or flame of fire.

Raghib says it means pure flame of fire, i.e. which is not mixed with smoke.

“تلاظت” (*talazzat*): the fire flared up {T, M}.

The Quran says:

70:15	fire with flames	كَأَنَّا إِنَّمَا آلَظَى
92:14	fire which is flaring up	نَارًا تَلْظَى

L-Ain-B ل ع ب

“لُعَاب” (*lu-aab*): saliva of the mouth.

“لَعِبَ فُلَانٌ” (*laa-iba fulaan*): he worked without the right aim {T, M}.

Muheet concurs and adds that it also means work which is useless. It also means to like improper matters and to derive pleasure from them, or to turn to useless things instead of engaging in fruitful things.

“لَاعِبٌ” (*laa-ib*): player {T, L}.

“لَعِبٌ” (*laa-ibb*) is the opposite of “جِدٌّ” (*jidd*) which means to do something seriously. Therefore “لَعِبٌ” (*laa-ibb*) means to be non-serious about a thing.

“لَعِبَ بِنَا الْمَوْجُ” (*laa-iba minal mauj*) is said when the waves do not take the boat towards its destination.

“لَعِبٌ” (*laa-ib*) would mean movement but without result, useless word or deed.

“إِنَّمَا أَنْتَ لَاعِبٌ” (*innama anta laa-ib*): you are not taking it seriously {T, L}. Also see heading (**L-He-W**).

Keys say that “لَهُوٌ” (*lahuwa*) means to turn away from the truth, and “لَعِبٌ” (*laa-ib*) means to turn to falsehood {M}.

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:57	Those who take your Deen non-seriously, do not make them your friends:	هُزُواْ وَ لَعِبًا
6:92	So shun them and let them play with their nonsensical things	وَدَّرَهُمْ فِي خُوضِهِمْ يَلْعَبُونَ

This is about those who think that life is merely a plaything, or a joke – do not take it seriously.

The Quran has directed us to keep our eyes on the future. The future covers many aspects of our life: for example thinking about the oncoming life instead of living it up in the present, the thought about the future generations, the consideration about the welfare of the entire humanity, the pursuit of the higher ideals of life as compared to the immediate benefits of this life, etc. Contrary to this is the way of not thinking at all about the life in the hereafter and live it for the immediate gains and pleasures of this life.

The Quran says this life is merely a plaything:

6:32	To devote all of one's energies towards the luxuries of this life waste of efforts and time	وَمَا الْحَيَوةُ الدُّنْيَا إِلَّا لَعِبٌ وَهْوٌ
6:32	those who wish to benefit in the hereafter must understand that the benefits of the future life are something for which they need to make an effort through righteousness	وَلِلْآخِرَةِ الْأَجْرُ خَيْرٌ لِلَّذِينَ يَتَّقُونَ

“لَهْوٌ” (*lahwa*): to turn a man's attention from that which is essential to things which are useless and meaningless. This does not mean that the Quran thinks that the life of this world is lowly - not at all. It says a **momin's** life comprises of the struggle to attain the pleasantness in this life and to conquer the forces of the universe. See heading (**D-N-W**). It simply means that one should not lose sight of the benefits of the future in favour of the immediate benefits of this life. It does not support existence merely on an animal level: it says whenever there is a clash of interests between the benefits of the future life and the benefits of this life then the latter should be sacrificed in **favor** of the former: nations which do not think of the future are destroyed: individuals too: the Quran always advocates to go for the benefits of the future: it does advocate acquisition of the benefits of this life but not at the cost of the future life: if you do not sacrifice the benefits of this life for the benefits of the future, when and if there is confrontation between the two, then it will mean that you take life non-seriously.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says:

21:16	And We have not created this system of the universe without reason	وَمَا خَلَقْنَا السَّمَاءَ وَالْأَرْضَ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا لَاعِبِينَ
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It is not without a serious purpose. It has a great purpose. It has been created as part of a great program.

21:18	Constructive forces continuously are battling destructive forces and destroying them	نَعْدِفُ بِالْحَقِّ عَلَى الْبَاطِلِ فَيَذَ مَعَهُ فَاذَا هُوَ حَقٌّ
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Thus this system is evolving. It is obvious that a thing which has been created frivolously cannot be like this. The Quran in this verse has also contradicted the belief which is prevalent among the Hindus according to which God has created this universe as a plaything. They say that their **Eshwar** (God) is also called **Nat rajan** which means “the king of plays”.

The Quran says that this concept is nonsense:

21:18	This sort of talk is the basis of destruction and ultimate regret	وَلَكُمْ الْوَيْلُ بِمَا تَصِفُونَ
30:8	The universe has been created with truth (i.e. truly with a purpose).	وَمَا خَلَقَ اللَّهُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا إِلَّا بِالْحَقِّ

As such, every matter regarding the universe or human life must be taken seriously. It should not be thought of as a joke and it should be kept in mind that there is a purpose to this life. This has broken Plato's myth according to which the universe was merely a fraud or a sham, and with it demolished the

structure of *Waidaant* or real Monasticism or rebirth and also monasticism. Materialism is also refuted which says life is only physical and materialistic.

La'al

لَعَلَّ

“لَعَلَّ” (*la'al*): creates the following meanings:

1) To mean “so that”.

2:189	protect the laws of God (observe them) so that your fields (lives) are productive	وَ اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ
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It appears for expectation and hope. So in this light this verse would mean “it is hoped that...” or “it is expected that...”

The Quran has said that “كتاب” (*kitaab*) and “حكمة” (*hikmat*) are both from Allah (2:231, 17:39, 4:113). “كتاب” (*kitaab*) means the laws and “حكمة” (*hikmat*) means the reason for it which that law has been made for. “لَعَلَّ” (*la'alla*) appears to explain this “حكمة” (*hikmat*) i.e. the reason behind an injunction.

“وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ” (*wat taqul laaha*) is the book (i.e. law or order) and “لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ” (*la'allakum tuflihoon*) is the reason that law, or the result which will accrue if that law is followed.

2) To mean “perhaps” or “maybe”.

42:17	So all of you may know the moment of that revolution may well be near	وَمَا يُدْرِيكَ لَعَلَّ السَّاعَةَ قَرِيبٌ
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3) To mean as a rhetoric question.

11:12	So you may abandon a part of the guidance (in order to please them)? (no, you will never do so)	فَلَعَلَّكَ تَارِكٌ بَعْضَ مَا يُوحَىٰ إِلَيْكَ
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4) Sometimes it appears to mean ‘as if’ or ‘so that’.

26:129	And you indulge in machinations as if you are to stay here forever	وَتَتَّخِذُونَ مَصَانِعَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَخْلُدُونَ
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It may also mean “you go to all this trouble of creating things as if they will give you permanence”- note how the Quran refers to the human thought process.

L-Ain-N

ل ع ن

“لَعَنَّ” (*laa'un*): to distance from somebody due to displeasure, to shun somebody {R}.

“لَعْنَتُ” (*la'anat*) from Allah would mean for a man to be deprived of the happiness of life. Obviously this deprivation will be the result of living against the laws of Allah.

“لَعْنَتُ” (*la'nat*) would mean to be deprived of the good things of life due to the natural result.

“الْلَعِينُ” (*al-laeen*): scare crow {T}.

The Quran has said about *Iblees*:

15:34	Then surely you are expelled	فَإِنَّكَ رَجِيمٌ
15:35	And indeed upon you there shall be <i>la'nat</i>	إِنَّ عَلَيْكَ اللَّعْنَةَ

“رَجِمَ” (*rajm*): to throw something away. This too explains the meaning of “لَعْنَتُ” (*la'nat*)

The Quran says the Jews claimed that the Quran's teachings could never affect them, and that their hearts were covered and protected.

The Quran says:

2:88	It is not that! Due to their denial and rebelliousness their hearts have been sealed (from accepting the Quran)	بَلْ لَعَنَهُمُ اللَّهُ بِكُفْرِهِمْ
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And this has happened due to the natural consequences of not accepting the guidance – note here a reference is made to the human thought process which is affected by the nature of the values and their consequences.

Those who say that “Allah rains ‘لَعْنَتٌ’ (*la'nats*) on those who refuse to believe are wrong: Allah never uses any execrable words. The term simply means the effect of the Law of Requit, which is that anyone who adopts the wrong path gets deprived automatically of the good things of life i.e. this as well as the hereafter. The result of this wrong path is called ‘لَعْنَتٌ’ (*la'nat*) and those individuals or nations which do so are called ‘مَلْعُونٌ’ (*mala'oon*).

L-Gh-B ل غ ب

“لَغَبٌ” (*laghab*: “لَغْبًا” (*laghba*), “لُغُبًا” (*lughuba*): to be very tired, exhausted {T}
 “النَّصَبُ” (*an-nasab*): bodily tiredness.
 “الْغُوبُ” (*al-laghub*): mental or psychological tiredness {T}.
 “سَهْمٌ لَغِبٌ” (*sahmun laghib*): the arrow with very bad feathers at its tail end.
 “رَجُلٌ لَغِبٌ” (*rajulun laghib*): weak and foolish man {R}.

The Quran contains the saying of those who dwell in the *jannat*:

35:35	It will not tire body or mind {T}	لَا يَمَسُّنَا فِيهَا نُصَبٌ وَلَا يَمَسُّنَا فِيهَا لُغُوبٌ
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Note how high and fine are the next stages of life that the Quran promises us. There shall be no physiological tiredness or psychological tiredness. How this condition will prevail in the life after death we cannot say with our present level of knowledge, but obviously that life would be full of energy - the Quran has referred to these states in various verses.

L-Gh-W ل غ و

“اللُّغَةُ” (*al-lugha*): language
 “لُغَوْتُ” (*laghautu*), “لُغَوْتُ” (*laghwa*): I spoke.

Some think that “اللَّغْوُ” (*al-laghwu*) means to throw or insert.
 “لُغْوٌ” (*lahwun*): speech because it is also cast {T}.

Muheet says it could have been derived from the Greek word ‘logos’ which means sentence or word {M}.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings. One meaning is of an insignificant thing which deserves no attention. Second meaning is the prominence or ubiquity of a thing or to talk about it all the time.

Therefore as per the previous meaning “اللَّغْوُ” (*al-laghwu*) means the kids of a camel which are not acceptable as compensation, and as per the second meaning “اللُّغَةُ” (*al-lugha*) means language because everyone likes his language and uses it in speech.

“اللَّغَا” (*al-lagha*) and “اللَّغْوُ” (*al-laghwu*) mean the sound of a bird.

“الطَّيْرُ تَلْغَى بِأَصْوَاتِهَا” (*at-tairu talgha bi aswatiha*): birds make their own sounds.

“لَغْوٌ” (*laghwu*): meaningless talk or slips of the tongue {T}.

Raghib says “لَغْوٌ” (*laghwu*) is the speech which comes out thoughtlessly.

Khaleel says that “لَغْوٌ” (*laghwu*) is a speech that comes out without thought {T}.

“كَلِمَةٌ لَا غِيَةَ” (*kalimatun laaghiyah*): dirty talk.

“لَغَا فِي قَوْلِهِ” (*lagha fi qaulihi*): he made a mistake in saying.

“الْغَاهُ” (*al-ghaah*): he was unrequited, or made unsuccessful, or made useless.

“الْلُغَى” (*al-lagha*): a useless thing {T}.

Surah **Al-Baghr** says:

2:225	Allah doesn't hold you to your superfluous promises (<i>swearings</i>). Holds you only to those which are truly from your heart.	لَا يُؤَاخِذُكُمُ اللَّهُ بِاللَّغْوِ فِي أَيْمَانِكُمْ وَلَكِنْ يُؤَخِذُكُمْ بِمَا كَسَبْتُمْ قُلُوبُكُمْ
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This makes the meaning of “لَغْوٌ” (*laghwu*) clear, that is, the things you say without intent and that come out of your mouth meaninglessly. At another place after “لَغْوٌ” (*laghwu*) it is said:

5:89	The firm pacts that you make from your heart	وَلَكِنْ يُؤَخِذُكُمْ بِمَا عَقَّدْتُمُ الْأَيْمَانَ
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It means such a pact that is heartfelt, and that which you fully comprehend and decide with full intent. This too makes the meaning of “لَغْوٌ” (*laghwu*) clear.

About the wine of **jannat**, it is said:

52:23	It will neither make man say useless things nor create stupor (56:25)	لَا لَغْوَ فِيهَا وَلَا تَأَنٍّ
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At another place it is said about the **jannat**:

19:62	It will have everything that promises peace and solidarity: there will be no laghwu	لَا يَسْمَعُونَ فِيهَا لَغْوًا إِلَّا سَلَامًا
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In Surah **Al-Ghaashia**, “لَا غِيَةَ” (*laghia*) has appeared in place of “لَغْوٌ” (*laghwu*) in (88:11).

Momineen are said to be:

25:72	If they ever have to face something laghu then they pass by very seriously (or avoid it)	إِذَا مَرُّوا بِاللَّغْوِ مَرُّوا كِرَامًا
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Here **laghu** means improper things.

The above examples make the meanings of “لَغْوٌ” (*laghu*) clear, that is, useless or improper things, or talk that is not befitting a gentleman, or meaningless talk, or only sounds with no real meaning, or talk which is thoughtlessly indulged in, or work which does not produce any result. In a society of the **momineen**, no such thing will be found.

At one place in the Quran it is said about the **kuffaar** that they used to tell their colleagues that:

41:26	do not listen to the Quran	لَا تَسْمَعُوا لِهَذَا الْقُرْآنِ
41:26	Wherever the Quran is being recited, indulge in useless talk.	وَالْعَوَاقِبِ

Today, this advice is given to the Muslims i.e. they are advised not to go directly to the Quran but to other books!

This is the way to distract from the Quran: this will help you overcome them (those who invite to the Quran): because if the people ever hear the Quran then they will never be satisfied with your self-created religion.

As such anything, any talk, any concept, any thought, any deed, any ideology, that keeps man away from the Quran is “لَغْوٌ” (*laghu*). We too have been indulging in “لَغْوٌ” (*laghu*) things since centuries and till we cleanse our hearts and minds of these “لَغَوِيَّاتٌ” (*laghwiyaats*), we can never reach the pure **Deen** – as a consequence people will never benefit from the teachings of the Quran.

“لَفَّتَهُ” (*lafatahu*), “يَلْفِتُهُ” (*yalfituhu*): to detract someone from his way, or to turn him away from the direction he faces, or to return.

“لَفَّتَهُ عَنِ الشَّيْءِ” (*lafatahu unish shaiyi*): turned him away from something or reverted him {T}.

The Quran says:

10:78	Have you come to us to turn us away from the path of our forefathers and take us to another way?	أَجْمَعْتُمْ لِنُفِيتَنَا عَمَّا وَجَدْنَا عَلَيْهِ آبَاءَنَا
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“الْتِفَاتٌ” (*iltifaat*): to change direction {T}.

“لَفَّتَهُ مَعَهُ” (*liftuhu ma'ahu*): he leans that way {M}.

“الْلَفُوتُ” (*al-lafuut*): a woman with a child from the previous husband and due to the attention she gives him she cannot attend properly to her current husband. It also means a she-camel which continuously looks at the man who milks her and shouts a lot because her child has passed away {T}.

In Surah *Al-Hoodh*, *Luut* has been told to leave his nation and get out of there:

11:81	And none of you should then turn around (leave everything and do not ever think of them again)	وَلَا يَلْتَفِتْ مِنْكُمْ أَحَدٌ
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“لَفْحٌ” (*lafh*): very hot wave of air.

“لَفْحٌ” (*lafhun*): every hot thing {Lissan-ul-Arab}.

“نَفْحٌ” (*nafkhun*): every cold thing {Lissan-ul-Arab}.

“لَفَحَتْهُ النَّارُ بِحَرِّهَا” (*lafhatun naaru harriha*): the fire singed him {T, R, M}.

Muheet says with reference to *Asma-ee*, that anything which is called “لَفْحٌ” (*lafah*) will be hot, and anything called “نَفْحٌ” (*nafah*) will be cold.

Surah *Al-Mominoon* says:

23:104	Fire will devastate their faces	تَلْفَحُ وُجُوهَهُمُ النَّارُ
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Ibn Faris says the word means to insert or throw something.

“لَفَظَهُ” (*lafazah*), “يَلْفِظُهُ مِنْ فِيهِ” (*yalfizuhu min feeh*): he threw it out of his mouth {T, R, M}.

“الْلَفَظَةُ” (*al-lalafizah*): the sea because whatever is in it, it throws out on the beaches.

It also means birds which feed their young ones because they feed them with whatever they bring in their beaks. It also means grist mill because whatever is put in it (wheat etc.) it throws out after grinding as flour. It also means a goat which stops grazing if a man arrives to milk her and she gets ready to be milked.

“الْلَفَازَةُ” (*al-lalfaazah*): that which is thrown out of the mouth {T}.

“لَفْظٌ” (*lafz*): the sound that comes out of the mouth.

“لَفْظُ اللَّهِ” (*lafzullah*) is not used but instead it is said “كَلِمَةُ اللَّهِ” (*kalimatil laah*) {M}.

The Quran says:

50:8	he doesn't say anything	مَا يَلْفِظُ مِنْ قَوْلٍ
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“الْلَفُّ” (*al-luff*): to wrap. It is the opposite of “نَشْرٌ” (*nashr*).

“لَفَّ الشَّيْءَ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*luffash shaiya bish shaiyi*): he mixed a thing with another.

“الْلَفُّ” (*al-liff*): party or group, or congregated people, or crowd with different sort of people, or people of different tribes gathered together.

“الْلَفِيفُ” (*al-lilfaafah*): belt.

“الْأَلْفَافُ” (*al-lafaff*): trees growing closely.

“جَنَّتِ الْأَفَافُ” (*jannatin alfaafa*): dense, thick, abundant trees in a garden (78:16).

Surah *Bani Israeel* says:

17:104	We will bring you together from all around	جَنِّتَابَكُمْ لَفِيفًا
75:29	intensity was added upon intensity (the difficulties kept mounting)	وَالْتَفَّتِ السَّاقُ بِالسَّاقِ

“الْتَفَّتِ” (*iltaff*): for one thing to embrace another, or wrap around another.

“سَاقٍ” (*saqa*): means calf of the leg {*T, R*}.

“الْفَاهُ كَاذِبًا” (*alfaahu kaaziba*): I found him to be a liar.

The Quran says:

12:25	They both found her husband near the door { <i>T</i> }.	وَالْفَيَّا سَيِّدَ هَالِدَى الْبَابِ
2:17	The beliefs we found our forefathers to have	مَا الْفَيْنَا عَلَيْهِ آبَائُنَا

“تَلَاَفَى التَّقْصِيرُ” (*talafat taqseer*): he atoned for the fault.

“الْتَلَاَفَى” (*at-talaafi*): to avenge {*T*}.

“تَلَاَفَى” (*talaafi*): to retrieve something that had gone out of hand.

“تَلَاَفَى مَافَاتٍ” (*talafi mafaat*): to regain that which had been lost.

“الْلَفَاءُ” (*al-lafa'a*): dust and any useless thing {*T*}, i.e. something which is begotten without any labour.

“الْلَقَبُ” (*al-laqaab*): a nomenclature which is not really one's name but which is later used for somebody.

Plural is “الْقَابُ” (*al-qaab*) {*T*}. There is a concession of meaning in his but in “أَعْلَامٌ” (*aalaam*) there is no concession of meaning {*R*}.

“لَقَبٌ” (*laqaab*) is of three kinds.

“لقب تَشْرِيفٍ” (*laqaab tashrif*), “لقب تَعْرِيفٍ” (*laqaab taarif*) and “لقب تَسْخِيفٍ” (*laqaab taskheef*). The third kind contains an element of insult {*M*}.

The Quran says:

6:11	do not call each other by bad names (demeaning names)	وَلَا تَنَابَرُوا بِالْأَلْقَابِ
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See heading (*N-B-Z*).

“لِقَاحٌ” (*liqaah*): sperm of camel or horse.

“الْلَقْحُ” (*al-laqaah*): conception.

“لَاقِحٌ” (*laaqih*): pregnant. Plural is “لَوَاقِحُ” (*lawaaqih*).

“لَقَحَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*laqihatn naaqaah*): she camel became pregnant.

“الْفَحَتِ الرِّيحُ الشَّجَرَ وَالسَّحَابَ” (*al-fahatis riyahush shajara was-sahaab*): the winds made the trees and the clouds fruitful {*T, R*} (by bringing pollen from other trees and thus fertilizing the trees) and the clouds by vaporizing water of the sea {*Ibn Faris*}.

“وَأَرْسَلْنَا الرِّيحَ لَوَاقِحَ” (*wa arsalnar riyaaaha liwaqi'a*): we send fruitful winds (15:22).

“الرَّيْحُ الْعَقِيمُ” (*ar reehal aqeen*): stormy winds, or barren winds (51:41).

“لَقَطٌ” (*laqat*), “يَلْقِطُ” (*yalqit*), “لُقْطًا” (*laqta*): to pick up some lowly or insignificant thing.

“الْلُقْطَةُ” (*al-luqtah*): anything that is lying on the ground and someone picks it up, or a newly born who is thrown away. It is also called “الْلُقَيْطُ” (*al-laqaet*) {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it means to pick up something from the ground suddenly and of which there is no prior intent. But sometime it can also be with intent.

The Quran says that *Yusuf's* brothers said “put him in the deep well”:

12:10	Some caravan will find him and take him along	يَلْتَقِطُهُ بَعْضُ السَّيَّارَةِ
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About *Moosa* it is said that when his mother set him afloat in the river:

28:2	Pharaoh's people picked him up	فَالْتَقَطَهُ آلُ فِرْعَوْنَ
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Raghib says it means to take something with good expertise and also with cunningness.

“لَقِفَ” (*laqif*), “يَلْقِفُ” (*yalqaf*): to quickly take something that is thrown to you, or to take it or snatch it quickly.

“التَّلْقِيفُ” (*at-talqeef*), “التَّلَاقِفُ” (*at-talaqquf*): to swallow food.

“التَّلْقِيفُ” (*at-talqeef*): while running for horses or camels to use front legs quickly and not let them go the full length towards the belly {*T, R*}.

“تَلَقَّفَ الشَّيْءَ” (*talaqqafash shaiyi*): to take something smartly and quickly {*T, R*}.

The Quran says about the staff of *Moosa*:

7:117	It swallowed the reasoning of the opponents without any reaction	فَإِذَا هِيَ تَلْقَفُ مَا يَأْفِكُونَ
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It means that the reasons could not stand up to him, or he stretched his hand and snatched them, or he snatched quickly whatever the sorcerers had made out. As the traditional translations go, it means that the fake snakes of the sorcerers were swallowed quickly by *Moosa's* python.

“الْلَقْمَ” (*al-laqm*): to eat quickly and fast:

“لَقِمَهُ” (*laqimah*): pulled it with his mouth and ate it quickly:

“الْتَقَمَهُ” (*iltaqamah*): he swallowed it in time {*T, R*}, i.e. first put it in his mouth and then swallowed it.

“لَقِمَ” (*laqima*) and “الْتَقَمَ” (*iltaqam*): to put something in mouth {*Lisan-ul-Arab*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to take mouthful to the mouth with a hand.

In relation to *Yunus* the Quran says:

37:143	A big fish put him in its mouth	فَاَلْتَقَمَهُ الْحُوتُ
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“لَقَمَ الطَّرِيقَ” (*laqamat tareeq*): he closed the entrance to the path {*T, R*}.

“الْقَمَةُ الْحَجَرُ” (*al-qamahul hajar*): in a quarrel or heated argument, he silenced his opponent {*M*}.

Luqmaan

لقمان

The Quran has mentioned *Luqmaan* with reference to knowledge and *hikmah i.e. wisdom*.

31:12	And indeed we gave <i>hikmah</i> to <i>Luqmaan</i>	وَلَقَدْ آتَيْنَا لُقْمَانَ الْحِكْمَةَ
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But he has not been called messenger, nor has he been described in detail. Only the advices he gave his son are mentioned (31:12-19).

Some say that he was the nephew of *Ayyub* (a messenger who is renowned for his forbearance). Some say he was born in the times of *Dawud* (another messenger). Some think that he was a Negro slave. Some think that he was the famous *Aesop* whose fables are so widely known.

Dr. Spanger thinks that it is the other name of *Elxai* of *Abyuna*. Professor *Hitti* supports this thought.

The Torah's Book of Examples says that his tales resemble those of *Yaqa's* son *Ajwar* (Example 30:1). The tales of *Tawayal* king (31:1) are similar to those of *Luqmaan*. Due to this guess he should belong to the *Bani Ismael*.

But all these are speculations. Further research may lead us to some definite conclusion in the future. But one thing is certain that if *Luqmaan* had access to the revelation (which the Quran has not mentioned) then *hikmah* would mean this guidance. If he was not given this guidance (as the Quran shows), then this would mean that he had the ability to comprehend the *hikmah*, or the laws of the revealed guidance.

In other words, *hikmah* is another name for the revealed guidance, and when this word is with reference to an ordinary human being's own thinking, then it means wisdom.

Imam Raazi says “لِقَاءٌ” (*liqa’a*) means for one body to touch another {T}.

Imam Raghīb says touching is not necessary for “لِقَاءٌ” (*liqa’a*), just to be facing one another is enough.

Some say that to comprehend something by visual means or insight is “لِقَاءٌ” (*liqa’a*).

“تِلْقَاءٌ” (*tilqaa’u*): in front {T}.

“يَوْمُ التَّلَاقِ” (*yaumut talaag*): the day in which one confronts or faces another, i.e. when results physically are made known (40:15).

“الِقَاءُ” (*ilqa’un*): to put one thing in front of another {R}.

“لِقَاءٌ” (*liqa’un*): war, when the forces are facing each other {M}.

Johri says that it is also said to mean to throw something away {T}.

Ibn Faris says it has three basic meanings.

- For two things to meet, or come face to face.
- To put something or lay something down.
- Crookedness which is called “الَلْفَوَّةُ” (*al-laquwah*).

The Quran says:

2:14	when they face the momineen	إِذْ الْقَوْمَ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا
2:37	Hence Adam got the laws of Allah	فَتَلَقَّى آدَمُ مِنْ رَبِّهِ كَلِمَاتٍ
15:19	And we casted within (earth) rigid mounts	وَ أَلْقَيْنَا فِيهَا زُلَاسِي

This word has also been used to mean “to put” in (20:39).

Surah *An-Namal* says that **Suleman** gave a servant his letter and said:

27:28	put this letter in front of her (deliver it to her)	فَأَلْقَاهُ إِلَيْهِمْ
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After this Queen **Saba** is recorded as having said:

27:29	A respected letter has been sent to me	إِنِّي أَلْقِي إِلَيْ كِتَابٍ كَرِيمٍ
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Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:68	tell him	فَأَلْقُوا إِلَيْهِمُ الْقَوْلَ
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Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:110	he who wants that Allah’s law should come before him in a palpable form must be steadfast on the program presented by the laws of Allah and use all his capabilities as called for by this system and keep this free from any other emotion or selfishness	فَمَنْ كَانَ يَرْجُوا لِقَاءَ رَبِّهِ فَلْيَعْمَلْ عَمَلًا صَالِحًا وَلَا يُشْرِكْ بِعِبَادَةِ رَبِّهِ أَحَدًا
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Therefore “لِقَاءِ رَبِّ” (*liqaa’i rab*) means for His system of Sustenance to manifest itself in palpable form, or for results of man’s deeds to manifest themselves according to the law of requital, and also for man never to forget that he is accountable to Allah through the Law of requital for every deed.

Finding inroads in “لِقَاءِ رَبِّ” (*liqaai rab*) means finding ways to avoid Allah’s law in one’s own practical life. Remember that according to the Law of requital the results of deeds manifest here in this life as well as the life hereafter, therefore “لِقَاءِ رَبِّ” (*liqaai rab*) is in this world as well as in the life hereafter. So far as the “لِقَاءِ رَبِّ” (*liqaai rab*) is concerned where man can see it manifest itself in palpable form the Quran asks man to conduct research and try to understand His system, and the law will manifest itself (13:2). But this will be done only by him who does not consider this life as the ultimate end (10:6-8). Such people are deprived of the blessings of Allah (29:32). From the context it can be determined as to what

the Quran means by “لِقَاءَ رَبِّ” (*liqaai rab*); whether it means to see the reference to the sustenance system unveiled or to see the result of deeds which shape up according to the Law of requital whether in this life or in the life hereafter.

Some think that verses about “لِقَاءَ رَبِّ” (*liqaai rab*) mean that man will see Allah in the hereafter, i.e. he will see Him face to face. Here one must be reminded that God’s personality is not material nor do we know that in the hereafter what will be the condition of human life. Therefore, to believe that man and God will face each other in the hereafter like a man faces another man in this world, would be wrong. We do not know how “لِقَاءَ رَبِّ” (*liqaai rab*) would be in the hereafter.

Generally it is believed that God does “إِلْقَاءَ” (*ilqa*) on a particular issue or thing to some elders. This is supposed to mean that the knowledge regarding a thing or issue was revealed directly by God through *kashf* or *ilhaam* to him. This has no certification from the Quran. Direct knowledge from God was received through the revelation in the past which has now stopped after the demise of the last Messenger *Muhammad*. If anyone says that somebody gets “*ilqa*” from God, it is like breaking the seal of the messenger-hood. Details of all this can be found in the heading (*W-H-Y*) and (*L-He-M*).

We often say that “a thought crossed my mind”, but such event has no connection with the revelation or “إِلْقَاءَ” (*ilqa*) or any such thing. This is all the working of the un-conscious mind about which we are still learning. Revelation is entirely different from this. That was a definite knowledge which was given directly from God to the messenger. Through the detailed understanding of the Quran all these issues get resolved and one comes to the conclusion that this is the complete book which deals with the human self-development providing guidance to the human intellect and reasoning (as there is no inner guidance) and there is no need for any other guidance as the book has all that is required to deal with the human life. It also provides answers to all the questions which human beings can think of during the course of their physical life and it gives ample understanding of the life in the hereafter. The Quran deals with the human thinking and its issues at a fundamental level and since what is there in the Quran is not the way human beings think, therefore no human mind can produce what is there in the book. The concept of Allah referred in the Quran is unique and is from the Creator Himself - it is an objective standard which cannot be found anywhere else in the world as human beings do not think the way the Quran contains the unique concept of Allah serving as a model for human beings. This model for the human self serves as a standard for guidance which makes one free from all the inner beliefs and chains which restrict human thought and prevent an individual from utilising his free will to its fullest potential. We do not need to see Allah as we do not need to see our inner self which we know exists as we are self-conscious of our own strong sense of identity. Our strong sense of identity, meta cognition, and memory defines our self which has its own existence separate from our physical body. The Quran invites us to ‘meet’ Allah through the signs and the evidence in the world and the universe around us (10:6-7) which is created for each one of us to develop our self and leave this life for another life – the Quran is the book of guidance to help develop our self in order to be able to live beyond the constraints of the physical death.

“يُلْقَى” (*yulaqqa*) means being given a capability

41:35	And the capability for this (important work) is given to those who observe the laws of God. It can only be begotten by such people.	وَمَا يُلْقَىٰهَا إِلَّا الَّذِينَ صَبَرُوا
10:15	From oneself.	مَنْ يُلْقَىٰءِ نَفْسِي

Likn لِكِنَّ

“لِكِنَّ” (*laakin*), “لِكِنَّ” (*laakinn*) appears to mean ‘but’:

75:31	So he neither confirms nor adopts the right path	فَلَا صَدَقَ وَلَا صَلَّى
75:32	But denies and tries to find ways of avoiding (Allah’s laws)	وَلَكِنَّ كَذَّبَ وَتَوَلَّى

Here if the word is translated to mean ‘rather’ then it will be more appropriate. This word appears both to mean “but” and “rather” or “instead”.

Surah *Al-Bagrah* says:

2:154	Instead the matter is that they are alive but this you do not understand at your present conscious level	بَلْ أَحْيَاءُ وَلَكِنَّ لَاتَشْعُرُونَ
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Here it means “but” or “instead”, i.e. they are alive but at the present level of your consciousness you cannot comprehend it.

Lum لَمْ

112:3	he gave birth to no one	لَمْ يَلِدْ
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“يَلِدُ” (*valid*) means to give birth, but with “لَمْ” (*lum*) as a predecessor it comes to mean the past tense and also the negative i.e. “no”, or “did not”, i.e. “did not give birth”.

Lumma لَمَّا

To mean “when”:

28:23	When he reached the watering site in <i>Madyan</i> .	لَمَّا وَرَدَ مَاءَ مَدْيَنَ
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To mean “not so far” or “not until now”:

38:8	They have so far not experienced my punishment	لَمَّا يَذُوقُوا عَذَابِ
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To mean “if”:

86:4	There is no individual that does not have a watchman over him. (There is no individual who doesn’t have an overseer over him)	إِنْ كُلُّ نَفْسٍ لَمَّا عَلَيْهَا حَافِظٌ
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To mean “all of them”:

11:111	Verily your Sustainer will give all of them the full return for their deeds.	إِنْ كُلًّا لَمَّا لِيَوْمَ يَجْتَمِعُ رَبُّكَ أَعْمَاءُ هُمْ
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Sometimes it is also redundant:

43:35	And all this are the accoutrements of the physical life	وَأَنْ كُلُّ ذَلِكَ لَمَّا مَتَاعُ الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا
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If “لَمَّا” (*lumma*) is taken out then too the meanings will not change. Perhaps “لَمَّا” (*lumma*) means “إِلَّا” (*illa*) here, as mentioned above in (86:4) {*T*}.

“لَمَحَ إِلَيْهِ” (*lamaha ilaih*): to look at someone sharply.

“الْلَمَحَةُ” (*al-lamhah*): to see quickly or to look at something quickly.

“الْمَحَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ مِنْ وَجْهِهَا” (*al-mahatil mar'atu min wajhiha*): the woman gave a glimpse of her beauty and then hid it. This is done generally by a woman with her lover {T}.

“الْلَمَحُ” (*al-lamh*): flash of a lightning because that too shines for a moment and then there is darkness.

“لَمَحَ الْبَصَرُ” (*lamahal basar*): for the eyes to rise towards something.

Ibn Faris says it means for something to shine.

The Quran says:

16:77	(the imminent revolution) is an eye bat away or even nearer than that	كَلِمَاحِ الْبَصَرِ أَوْ هُوَ أَقْرَبُ
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“الْلَمَزُ” (*al-lamz*): actually it means to indicate with eye, head or lips, and say something secretly, or to criticize to the face. Some also say it means back biting.

“لَمَزَهُ” (*lumazat*): a man who back bites and instigates two friends against each other {T, M}:

Ibn Faris says it basically means a fault.

The Quran says:

9:58	Those who criticize you in the distribution of the <i>sadaqaat</i> and thus try to create dissension in the party.	مَنْ يَلْمِزْكَ فِي الصَّدَقَاتِ
49:11	Do not criticize each other	لَا تَلْمِزُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ
104:1	those who criticize (finder of faults)	هُمَزَةٌ لَمَزَةٌ

Raghib says it means to find fault in others.

“لَمَسَ” (*lamas*), “يَلْمَسُ” (*yalmas*): to touch, or to look for something here and there {T, R}.

“الْتَمَسَ” (*iltamas*): to demand something, or search for something {T, R}.

Surah *Al-Jinn* says:

72:8	We searched the sky and made guesses as to the unseen.	أَنَّا لَمَسْنَا السَّمَاءَ
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Ibn Faris says with reference to **Ibn Dureed** that basically it means to touch but later also came to mean a searcher.

Surah *Al-Hadeed* says:

57:13	search for the light, to touch one another with the hand	فَا لْتَمِسُوا نُورًا
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It is said metaphorically for copulation {T, R}. The Quran says “أَوَلَمْ تَسْتُمِ النِّسَاءَ” (*au la mustumun nisa'a*) in (4:43).

“لَمَّ” (*lummah*), “يَلُمُّ” (*yalummuh*), “لَمَّا” (*lummah*): he deposited it.
 “لَمَّ الشَّعَثَ” (*lummash sha’as*): collected the dispersed elements and made them nearer.
 “دَارُنَا لُمُومَةً” (*daaru naalumah*): Our house is one to gather people and nourish them.
 “رَجُلُمٌ” (*rajulun milam*): the man who collects together a clan and a nation {T}.

Ibn Faris says the word basically means to congregate, become nearer, and to be joined.

Surah *Al-Fajar* says:

89:16	You alone devour the wealth that you get as inheritance	وَنَأْكُلُونَ الثَّرَاتِ أَكْلًا لَمًّا
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This expostulates that in a Quranic economic system there is no such thing as individual inheritance. The orders about inheritance contained in the Quran are for the interim period till a Quranic society is formulated. After the establishment of this system there is no need to leave anything in inheritance. Details can be found under relevant heading.

It can also mean that you leave out other heirs from the inheritance, or keep all for yourself. Such situation can exist in an Islamic system for an interim period. An Islamic society can continue with this division, for a short while or in an exceptional circumstance - aside from wealth, things of daily use can also be among the inheritance.

“أَلَمَ الرَّجُلُ” (*al-ummar rajul*): that man came close to sin, i.e. he didn’t actually commit it, but had the intention of doing it.

“لَمَّ” (*lamamun*) means to make a mistake sometime, according to some, but does not repeat this.

“لَمَّ” (*ilmaam*): to do something sometime but no repetition.

“مَا يَزُورُنَا إِلَّا لِمَا” (*ma yazuruna illa limaama*): he comes to our home sometimes.

“لَمَّ” (*lamam*) also means to kiss {T}.

Kalbi says “لَمَّ” (*lamam*) means to look at a person whom it is possible to get married by chance.

Johri says it means to come close to some sin but not to actually do it.

The Quran says about the *mominen*:

53:32	they abstain from big errors and dirty things except mistakes which man one can make without intent	وَالَّذِينَ يَجْتَنِبُونَ كَبِيرَ الْأَثْمِ وَالْفَوَاحِشَ إِلَّا اللَّمَمَ
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Sometimes such errors are not sins but do take one closer to sin. One should be careful lest such things happen again. Note how gradually the Quran adopts psychological reform which is not implemented at once.

If it comes with a transient verb then gives the meaning of the future, creates the sense of the negative, and creates stress in this negative.

Such as “لَنْ تَفْعَلُوا” (*lun taf’alu*) means that “you shall not do so at any cost”.

”لَهَبٌ“ (*lahab*): flame of fire.

”لَهَبٌ“ (*laheeb*): the heat of this flame.

”أَلَهَبَ النَّارَ“ (*alhaban naar*): he stoked the fire.

”فَالْتَهَبَتْ“ (*faltahabat*): so it flared up {T}.

”لَهَبٌ“ (*lahab*): dust storm {T}.

Raghib says ”لَهَبٌ“ (*lahab*) also means smoke {R}.

The Quran says:

77:31	He cannot save you from the flame of the fire	لَا يُغْنِيكَ مِنَ النَّارِ
111:1	who it has been said will enter <i>naran zaatil lahab</i>	أَبَى لَهَبٌ

Abu Lahab was the title of the Messenger’s uncle i.e. of *Abdul Azi bin Abdul Muttalib*, probably due to his fiery temper. He was a very strong opponent of Islam. He died a few days after the battle of **Badr** due to some epidemic.

The Quran has mentioned him particularly because he represents a certain type of people with a certain mentality. He was the caretaker of the House of Kaaba and knew that Islam’s success meant the demolishing of his authority and benefits, because Islam was dead against monasticism. He was dishonest to the extent that a golden deer which may have been offered as worship at the **kaaba** was reportedly stolen by him.

He was reported as coward (as those who do no work) that he did not take part in the battle of **Badr** in which nearly all the Quresh leaders took part and sent somebody in his place to the battle because he was indebted to him. As such when he died his relatives didn’t even come near his corpse and slaves had to bury him. Biggest thing of all, being a relative of the Messenger did not do him any good, because in Islam the criterion for closeness is deeds not lineage/relation.

”الْلَهَّاسُ“ (*al-lahaas*), ”الْلَهَّاسُ“ (*al-lahas*): thirst.

”الْلَهَّاسُ“ (*alluhaas*): the intensity of thirst, not be able to even stick out one’s tongue due to thirst, to pant, be tired, be an outcast {T}.

Raghib says that ”لَهَّاسٌ“ (*lahas*) means for the tongue to hang out due to thirst {R}.

Taj with reference to *Raghib* says that ”لَهَّاسٌ“ (*lahas*) means to breathe heavily due to tiredness.

”لَهَّاسُ الْكَلْبِ“ (*lahsal kalb*): for a dog to pant with his tongue protruding {*Ibn-e-Qateebah*} (7:176).

“لَهْمَه” (*lahimah*), “يَلْهَمَه” (*yalhamah*), “لَهْمَا” (*lahma*): to swallow something in one go.

“رَجُلٌ لَهِيمٌ” (*rajulun lahim*): a voracious eater {*Ibn-e-Qateebah*}.

“أَلْهَمَهُ الشَّيْءَ” (*alhamahus shaiyi*): he made him swallow a thing. “إِلْهَامٌ” (*ilhaam*) has come from this {*M*}.

The Quran says about the human psyche:

91:8	Man has been endowed with constructive and destructive attributes	فَأَلْهَمَهَا فُجُورَهَا وَتَقْوَاهَا
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Generally this verse is thought to mean that God has endowed man with the ability of distinguishing between good and bad, good and evil, light and darkness, but this is wrong. Excepting man, every other creature in the known universe has been instinctively granted guidance which it must follow. For example it is in the nature of water to flow downwards on a slope, and a goat instinctively shuns eating meat and eats grass instead. If man had been taught to distinguish between good and evil in the same way, then he would instinctively follow what was directed by his inbuilt instincts. Then every man would follow the right path, like every goat eats grass only. But as we know that is not the case. Every man does not follow the same path and has a choice. This shows clearly that man has not been endowed instinctively to follow the right path and shun the wrong one.

It is believed that man has been given this instinct but the environment and education and upbringing distort this nature of man, and he becomes whatever his parents or society makes him. If he was not affected by external influences then man too, every man would have adopted the same or right path. This is wrong too. Children have been found in jungles that due to some accident were separated from their parents and human society and when they grew up they acted just like animals. Therefore the concept that man has been endowed with the natural instinct of distinguishing between truth and falsehood has been proven wrong. For more details see heading (*F-T-R*).

Verse (91:8) would therefore mean that man has been created with potentials in him by the use of which he can disintegrate his personality. See heading (*F-J-R*). He also has potentials that can save him from this disintegration through his own efforts if he desires so. See heading (*W-Q-Y*).

The “هَ” (*ha*) of “فُجُورَهَا” (*fujuraha*) and “تَقْوَاهَا” (*tagwaha*) clearly show that both are conditions of the self. Therefore this verse means that man has been endowed with these two (constructive and destructive) potentials. Thereafter it is up to man himself to develop these latent bailities and give them whatever shape he likes. Whether he utilizes them for the development of his personality or its destruction (91:9).

As far as the concept of some elderly person getting direct knowledge from God is concerned, note that it has no support from the Quran. According to the Quran there are only two fountainheads of knowledge. One is direct knowledge from God towards a designated messenger. This was particular only to the messengers and with the end of messenger-hood this system has ended. The other source is the human intellect which every man can share. After the end of the messenger-hood we have two things left with us. One is that knowledge which we have received through the revelation via messengers, and the other is human intellect. The right thing now to do is to make decisions as per the human intellect under the light of the revelation; otherwise to believe that anyone gets direct knowledge from God (through *kashf* or *ilhaam*) is to break the seal of the end of messenger-hood. As stated above, the Quran is not at all supportive of the concepts of *kashf* or *ilhaam*. Neither is there any mention of the terms *kashf*, *ilhaam*, *wahi khafi* during the period of the Messenger of Allah. All these terms have been created afterwards and are actually borrowed from other religions. See heading (*W-H-Y*).

If man develops his thought or intent according to a particular fashion then he can perform such feats as seem magical to ordinary human intellect. People begin to think these as miracles and one who possess the power to work them as a person who has *kashf* or *ilhaam* and master of spiritual forces. But these things had nothing to do with *Deen*, but as said before these are elements of will power which any man without any discrimination of color, language or religion can develop and perform these ‘miracles’. It is a

fact that nowadays, in the West, especially in USA, these things are thought to help in overcoming psychological problems and veritable academies for teaching this art are being established.

It must be understood once more that direct knowledge from God could only be had through the revelation and this was done via messengers only. Since now messenger-hood has come to an end, therefore no man can acquire direct knowledge from God. Revelation is not the same as *ilhaam*, nor should one believe that any man can acquire knowledge from God directly.

L-He-W ل ه و

“لَهُو” (*lahu*) and “لَعِبٌ” (*la-ib*) are both words with same meaning. See heading (**L-Ain-B**), but linguist scholars have differentiated between them {*T*}. They say that thing that is similar between them is the meaning that man engages in useless pursuits and meaningless things and pursues emotional and temporary pleasures, but “لَهُو” (*lahu*) is more common than the word “لَعِبٌ” (*la-ib*). Some say that “لَعِبٌ” (*la-ib*) means to attain pleasure quickly and to enjoy it while “لَهُو” (*lahu*) means the pleasure which engages a man’s thought and mind.

Tarsusi says that “لَهُو” (*lahu*) means transient pleasure that detracts man from important things towards unimportant things, or work which has no clear or right direction {*T*}.

Raghib too says “لَهُو” (*lahu*) means work which detracts man from important work {*R*}.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings.

- For the attention to move away from something due to some other thing.
- To let something go.

The Quran says that human life is very precious as it has a great purpose and therefore it must be taken very seriously. Thus any temporary pleasure which detracts from the real purpose of life is “لَهُو” (*lahwun*) or “لَعِبٌ” (*la-ib*). The Quran has termed the transient benefits of this life as “لَعِبٌ” (*la-ib*) and “لَهُو” (*lahu*) in (47:36). The Quran gives a lot of importance to the life here too. It says any transient pleasure that detracts from the great purpose of life is “لَهُو” (*lahu*) and “لَعِبٌ” (*la-ib*).

It says that all that is “لَهُو” (*lahu*) and “لَعِبٌ” (*la-ib*) for which a man leaves the right path in order to be engaged in transient pleasure making in other words is equivalent of living at an animal level and is not living at a human level. These have been described as “لَهُوُ الْحَدِيثِ” (*lahwun hadees*) in (31:6). If “الْحَدِيثُ” (*al-hadees*) is taken to mean the Quran, then “لَهُوُ الْحَدِيثِ” (*lahwun hadees*) would mean things which make man oblivious of the Quran.

The points of view which make man take life frivolously or non-seriously have been called “لَا يَبْتَغِي قُلُوبُهُمْ” (*laahiyatam qulubuhum*) in (21:3).

“الْهَى” (*al-haa*): to keep busy, to engage, to shun the real purpose and engage in other things.

The Quran says:

102:1-2	Takaasur has diverted your attention from the important things of life and you keep following that path till you reach your graves	اَلْهٰكُمْ التَّكَاثُرُ حَتَّىٰ زُرْتُمُ الْمَقَابِرَ
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Takaasur means the wish to exceed in wealth. Note how the Quran in a few words depicts the entire human history. Now look at those who have acquired enough for their lifetime needs as well for their children, but still they are chasing wealth like mad.

Why do they do this? Simply to compete with others with a view to accumulate more than others. This will to accumulate and exceed others is the basis for all issues in the world. For individuals as well as

nations, man does have the competitive spirit in him and the will to excel. The Quran also supports this instinct but in a different field.

It says:

2:148	If you have to excel one another, then do it in righteous deeds in which everyone's welfare is included	فَاسْتَبِقُوا الْحَيْرَاتِ
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“تَلَاهَى عَنْهُ” (*talah-ha unhu*): to remove attention from him and look the other way (80:10).

“الْأَلْهَوَى” (*al-lahwu*), “الْأَلْهَوَى” (*al-lahwa*): the woman who is meant for pleasure. Later “الْهَوَى” (*lahwun*) came figuratively to mean woman {T}.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “الْهَوَى” (*lahwa*) in (21:17) means woman {T}.

Ibn Qateebah says “الْهَوَى” (*lahwa*) means son, woman and wedlock {*Al-Qurtain*}.

Raghib says that those who think this word means woman or son have taken this word's meaning as particular instead its common use.

Also see heading (*L-Ain-B*) along with *lahwun* to get the whole picture.

Lau لَوْ

“لَوْ” (*lau*) means “if”:

26:102	So if we are allowed to return just once, then we will become <i>momineen</i>	فَلَوْ أَنَّ لَنَا كَرَّةٌ فَنَكُونُ مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ
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Note that “لَوْ” (*lau*) generally is used for things which cannot possibly happen, i.e. it is said only to express an inequitable wish, as in the verse above where their return is not possible. If its translation is done as ‘supposing’ then it will also be befitting.

It also means “only if” along with “if”, in order to express a wish (15:2, 26:102).

To mean “that” as in:

26:102	Those with the Book include many who want to turn you into disbelievers after that you have believed	فَلَوْ أَنَّ لَنَا كَرَّةٌ فَنَكُونُ مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ
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“لَا” (*la*) also comes with “لَوْ” (*lau*) to mean the negative, such as:

34:31	if not for you we would be <i>momins</i> surely	لَوْلَا أَنْتُمْ لَكُنَّا مُؤْمِنِينَ
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To mean “why not”, as in:

25:7	why wasn't some angel sent to him	لَوْلَا أَنْزَلَ إِلَيْهِ مَلَكٌ
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“لَوْلَا” (*lau la*) as meaning ‘no’:

10:98	There is no such dwelling which...	فَلَوْلَا كَانَتْ قَرْيَةٌ---
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Sometime instead of “لَوْلَا” (*lau la*), “لَوْ مَا” (*lau ma*) is used:

18:7	If you are from among the truthful then why do you not bring the <i>malaikah</i> (angels) to us?	لَوْ مَا نَأْتِينَا بِالْمَلَائِكَةِ إِنْ كُنْتَ مِنَ الصَّادِقِينَ
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The important basic meanings of this root are “to appear” i.e. “to be evident” and “to shine”

“الْأَخَ الْبَرَقُ” (*alaahal burq*): the lightning shone {F}.

“الْلَوْحُ” (*al-lauh*): any wide wood or bone. The plural is “الْوَاهُ” (*al-waah*) {T}.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:145	We have made mandatory the morals of all matters for Moosa which are written on the tablets, or which we had gathered together for Moosa	وَكَتَبْنَا لَهُ فِي الْأَلْوَاهِ مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ مَوْعِظَةً
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Nooh's boat has been called:

54:13	that which is made up of boards and nails	ذَاتِ الْوَاحِ وَدُسُرٍ
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About the Quran it is said:

85:22	In evident safety	فِي لَوْحٍ مَحْفُوظٍ
56:78	A book well-guarded	كِتَابٍ مَكْنُونٍ

This Quran is not only safe with God but is in book form with us too. The knowledge from God that is safe from all types of external influences and change and destruction

“الْلَوْحُ” (*allauh*) means to shine as well as to see.

“لَاَحَهُ بَبَصَرِهِ لَوْحَةً” (*lahahu bibasari hi lauhah*): he saw it then it disappeared (or hid), i.e. he saw only a glimpse of it.

It also means thirst {T}.

“لَوْحَهُ بِالنَّارِ تَلْوِيحًا” (*lawwahahu binnari talviha*): heated in the fire.

“لَوْاحُ” (*lawwahun*): that which burns and changes its colour due to the burning {T}.

About the fires of hell, the Quran says:

74:29	That which changes the color of the skin	لَوَّاحَةٌ لِلْبَشَرِ
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Ibn Faris has said that “لَوْحَةُ الْحَرِّ” (*lawwahahul har*) means “heat burned it and turned it black so that he could be identified at a distance”.

“لَوْحَ الرَّجُلِ تَلْوِيحًا” (*lawwahar rajulu talvihaa*): that man pointed from afar {M}.

“الْأَخَ الْبَرَقُ” (*alaahal burq*): the lightning struck.

“لَاَحَ النَّجْمِ” (*laahun najm*): the star shone or twinkled {T}.

As such, “لَوْحُ” (*lauh*) has an element of light and brightness. Every revealed Book has light and brightness as in (4:275). The Quran and the Torah have been called as **noor** or light in (6:92).

“الْلُوْذُ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*al-lauzu bish shaiyi*): to hide behind something and thus be safe.

“الْلُوْذُ” (*al-lauz*): the edge of a mountain, or a turn of a valley.

“الْمَلَادُ” (*al-malaaz*): sanctuary, fort.

“الْمَلَاوِذَةُ” (*al-malawazatu*), “الْلَوَاذُ” (*al-liwaaz*): to hide behind one another or to scheme and avoid {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

24:63	Those among you who quietly slip away	يَسْتَلْزِمُونَ مِنْكُمْ لَوَاذًا
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Zajaaj says the next few words of this verse show that this word means “to oppose” {*T, R*}.

But in the former meaning too “avoiding the orders” are clear as “to slip quietly away” is a sort of attempt to avoid orders.

Loot

لُوطٌ

Loot had migrated to Palestine. He was a messenger and God had ordered him to go towards **Sodom**, along the shores of the Red Sea. An old trail of ancient caravans goes up to **Aqba** etc. after passing through **Hijaaz** and **Madyan**.

Sodom was situated along this very trail. It is thought that this area was near the present Dead Sea and a big part of it came below this sea due to an earthquak. The people toward whom **Loot** was sent as messenger lived in this area. From the Quran it can be understood that many messengers had come to these people before **Loot** and he too was so long a resident that he was called their **akhuhun** or brother (26:160).

This nation was indulging in the shameful act of homosexuality (26:165). Besides that, it was also involved in crimes of piracy and highway robbery (29:29). He told them to desist from these shameful acts but they paid no heed to him, and as a result this nation was destroyed.

The area of the **Sodom** was full of volcanoes and mines of sulphur. When volcanoes erupt they spew out smoke and rocks which go afar. It appears the nation of **Loot** was also destroyed in this way. The sulphur mines caught fire and earthquakes took place due to which the land collapsed and habitations was buried under the Dead Sea.

The Quran has related these details in different ways:

7:84	We made heavy rain on them	أَمْطَرْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ مَطَرًا
11:82	We rained stones on them which were cooked in the fire	أَمْطَرْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ حِجَارَةً مِنْ سِجِّيلٍ مَنْضُودٍ
15:73	a dreadful sound overtook them	فَأَخَذَتْهُمْ الصَّيْحَةُ
53:34	We sent a storm of stones towards them	إِنَّا أَرْسَلْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ حَاصِبًا

As to how natural phenomenon become the punishment of God, see the heading **Nooh** in the book titled **Jooyi-e-Noor**.

“لَا طَ الشَّيْءُ بِقَلْبِي” (*laatash shaiyi biqalbi*): thing stuck to my heart (mind) {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says this is its basic meaning.

“لَامَ” (*laam*): to scold someone, to shame him, to give someone a dressing down {*T, M*}.
 “لَوْمَةً” (*laumah*): insult.
 “لَاإِمَّ” (*laa-im*): one who scolds.

14:22	Do not scold me, but blame yourself	فَلَا تَلُومُنِي وَ لُومُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ
5:54	They do not fear anyone who calls them bad names or blames them	لَا يَخَافُونَ لَوْمَةَ لَائِمٍ

“لَوْمَ” (*lawwaam*): one who insults too much.
 “مَلُومٌ” (*maloom*): he who has been insulted (51:54).
 “مُلِيمٌ” (*muleem*): one who deserves insult (37:142).
 “يَتَلَاوَمُونَ” (*yatla wammoon*): began blaming or insulting each other (68:30).
 “لَوْمَةً” (*loomah*): to wait for something or somebody {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings of this root are “wrath” and “to insult” and “to remove”.

The Quran says “النَّفْسُ اللَّوَامَةُ” (*an-nafasil lawwama*) in (75:2). For its detailed meaning see the heading (*N-F-S*). It will suffice to mention here that there is no such force in man that tells him what the truth is and what falsehood is. Only the revelation can guide in this matter. See heading (*L-H-M*). There is a feeling and thinking (guilt) in man which admonishes him when he does something bad in reference to some standard or belief. This is the force which we call “conscience”. The voice of the conscience however cannot distinguish between truth and falsehood. It will support you on what you think is right and will admonish you for what you think is bad. It will be happy if the son of a *muslim* eats meat but admonish the son of a vegetarian for eating the same sort of meat. Therefore the voice of the conscience cannot be the standard for good and evil. “*Fatwa*” or decree as to how to act should always be sought from the revelation and not from one’s own mind. The conscience of robbers never admonishes or scolds them for robbing people. Highway robbers have no problem in robbing innocent travellers. The robbers barons of today’s world are those in power in strong nations, and are never bothered by their consciences for building palaces with the blood and sweat of weaker nations. Therefore only the guidance of God i.e. the Quran can decide between right and wrong, not man.

“الْوَنَ” (*al-laun*): any characteristic that makes one more prominent than others, as kind or type {*T*}.
 Since the most prominent or visible characteristic of anything is its color, therefore “لَوْنٌ” (*laun*) came to mean colour {*T*}.

“الْوَنَ” (*ilwun*): became colourful.
 “الْمُتَلَوِّنَ” (*almutalawwin*): that which does not stay in one color, or keeps changing color.

The Quran has said that the difference of languages and “الْوَانُ” (*alwaan*) or colors is a manifestation of truth for those with knowledge and insight (30:22). Here “الْوَانُ” (*alwaan*) means races, research on which is a big area of human study. But if “الْوَانُ” (*alwaan*) is taken to mean colour, then too this verse points to a great truth. Modern research says if you have to judge the mental level of a nation in some era then you must find out as to how many colours that nation recognizes. The more colours it could identify, the higher is its mental level. That means, distinguishing colours is connected to the development of the mind. For details, refer to *Dr. Bucke’s* book *Cosmic Consciousness*.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:13	And whatever He has multiplied for you in the earth of different kinds	وَمَا دَارَ الْكُفَىٰ فِي الْأَرْضِ مِثْلًا لَّوَانَةٍ
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“لَوَى الْحَبْلَ يَلْوِيهِ لَيًّا” (*lawal habla yalvihi laiyya*): twisted the rope and doubled it.
 “لَوَى بِرَأْسِهِ” (*lawa bi raasihi*): he turned his head away i.e. he avoided {T}.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is to turn something away.

In (63:5) “لَوَى لِسَانُهُ بَكَذَا” (*lawa lisaanuhu bikaza*) is a reference to fabricating lies and guess work {R}.

The Quran uses these words for “to mince words”, or “to lie”, or “to exaggerate” (3:77, 2:46)

“لَا تَلِيْهُ عَنْ كَذَا” (*yalituhu un kaza*): turned him away from something.
 “لَا تَهْ” (*laatah*), “لَا تَهْ” (*aalaatuhu*): reduced it, or did not give its full right {R}.

Ibn Faris says “الْلَيْتُ” (*al-leetu*) means “one side of the neck” and “الْلَيْتُ” (*al-laitu*) means “to reduce” and that no guess work can be done in case of these meanings.

Surah *Al-Hijraat* says:

49:14	He will reduce nothing from your (good) deeds	لَا يَلْتَكُمُ مِنْ أَعْمَالِكُمْ شَيْئًا
52:21	And We will not deprive their deeds in any way	وَمَا أَكْتَنُهِمْ مِنْ عَمَلِهِمْ مِنْ شَيْءٍ

Some think that it is from “الَّتْ” (*alat*) and “لَاتْ” (*laat*) and that “الَّتْ” (*alat*) have the same meaning.
 Some say it is from “وَلَتْ” (*waltun*) so it has been mentioned therein too.

“لَا يَت” (*lait*): only if...

“لَا يَتْنِيْ مِنْ قَبْلِ هَذَا” (*ya laitani mitttu qabla haaza*): only if I had died before this... (19:23).

“لَا يَس” (*lais*) appears to mean ‘no’.

“لَا يَسَ الْبِرَّانَ” (*laisal birra un...*): it is not the way of righteousness ... (2:177).

This verb is used only to express the different forms of past tense such as “لَسْتُ” (*lasta*), “لَسْتُ” (*lastu*), “لَسْتُ” (*lastum*), “لَسْتُ” (*lastunn*) etc.

“الْلَيْلُ” (*al-lailu*), “الْلَيْلَةُ” (*al-lailah*): night which is the time from sunset to sunrise {T}.

The *Muheet* says that in Hebrew *lail* means night and in Syrian it is called *lilya*.

Its plural is “لَيَالٍ” (*liyaal*) and “الْلَيَالِي” (*al-liyaali*).

Surah *Al-Maryam* says about *Zakaria*:

19:10	Do not talk to any person for three nights	لَا تُكَلِّمُ النَّاسَ ثَلَاثَ لَيَالٍ سَوِيًّا
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This means not three nights but three days and nights, i.e. three continuous days which also include the nights. This is because in (3:40) the same thing has been called “ثَلَاثَةَ أَيَّامٍ” (*talaata ayyaam*) which means “days”. But there is a fine difference between these two.

3:20	You shall not speak to any person, except with gestures	قَالَ آيَتُكَ إِلَّا تُكَلِّمُ النَّاسَ ثَلَاثَةَ أَيَّامٍ إِلَّا رَمْرًا
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As you see, there is no *illa ramza* or “except with gestures” in (19:10). Therefore the order for the days was different from that for the nights.

Surah *Al-Ibrahim* relates the purpose of the Quran’s revelation:

14:1	So that you can (through it) bring the mankind out of darkness into light	لِيُخْرِجَ النَّاسَ مِنَ الظُّلُمَاتِ إِلَى النُّورِ
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Thus this means that before the advent of the Quran the era has been called night or *lail*, i.e. an era in which there was darkness (ignorance) all around. There was no light of enlightenment anywhere. The Quran was revealed at such a time and introduced new standards of morality to the world. In darkness there are dangers lurking for man, whether in reality or in conception, because of the light of enlightenment these fears were dispelled and security was achieved. Later this enlightenment was completed in a way so as not to leave any portion of darkness behind.

“هِيَ حَتَّىٰ مَطْلَعِ الْفَجْرِ” (*hatta matla-il fajr*): entire world was illuminated by God’s light (97:1-5). Therefore, this dark era turned into an enlightened era for man due to the advent of the Quran (44:3).

L-Y-N

ل ي ن

“لَانَ الشَّيْءُ” (*lanashae’i*): a thing got soft.

“الْيَيْنُ” (*al-liyin*): softened him/it up {*T, M*}.

“الْلَيْنُ” (*allabbin*): soft.

About the messenger *Muhammed* the Quran says:

3:159	You dealt gently with them	لَئِنْ هُمْ
3:159	And if you had been rude and harsh in your heart...	وَلَوْ كُنْتَ فَظًّا غَلِيظَ الْقَلْبِ

Also see heading (*F-Zd-Zd*) and (*Gh-L-Zd*): This softness was for those who had joined the Messenger and had willingly bowed before the truth. Those who were engaged in opposing the truth found the Messenger and his companions to be tough and hard.

About *Dawud* it is said:

34:10	We made the iron soft for him	وَالْكَالَةَ الْحَدِيدَ
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It means that he got the knowledge of softening iron (either by melting or heating).

Surah *Al-Taha* says:

20:44	You two talk to him (the Pharaoh) softly.	فَقُولَا لَهُ قَوْلًا لَّيِّنًا
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“الْلَيْنَةُ” (*al-leenah*): date palm {*T, M*}.

Taj says that it means the date trees except two kinds which grow high quality dates. Most scholars have listed it under the heading (*L-W-N*).

This word is used in various contexts as noted below:

1) To mean “whatever”:

16:96	whatever you have will be gone	مَا عِنْدَكُمْ يَنْفَدُ
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2) To mean “which”:

4:22	do not wed women that your fathers have wed:	وَلَا تَنْكِحُوا مَا نَكَحَ آبَاؤُكُمْ مِنَ النِّسَاءِ
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3) To mean “what thing”, or “which thing”:

20:17	And what is this thing....	وَمَا تِلْكَ
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4) To mean “a condition”:

9:7	Till they respect the agreements made with you, you also abide by them.	فَمَا اسْتَقَامُوا لَكُمْ فَاسْتَقِيمُوا لَهُمْ
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5) To mean “how” and expressing surprise:

2:175	so isn't it surprising for them to remain on the wrong path?	فَمَا أَصْبَرَهُمْ عَلَى النَّارِ
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“مَا” (*maa*) does not appear by itself rather as “مَا أَفْعَلُ” (*maa fa'ala*) i.e. combined with another action.

6) To mean “as far as”:

64:16	As far as you can, observe the laws of Allah (i.e. the Quran).	فَا تَقُوا لِلَّهِ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ
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7) To mean “no”:

2:16	so their commerce was not beneficial or profitable	فَمَا رَاحَتْ بِحَارِثَتُهُمْ
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8) Sometimes it is redundant:

7:10	very few of you are thankful	قَلِيلًا مَّا تَشْكُرُونَ
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Although “مَا” (*maa*) here may also mean what “الَّذِي” (*allaazi*) or “those who”.

Note: sometimes instead of “مَا” (*maa*) only “م” (*m*) appears:

27:35	what do messengers return with (in reply):	بِمَ يَرْجِعُ الْمُرْسَلُونَ
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9) “مَاذَا” (*maa za*) means ‘what’:

2:215	They ask you as to how much they should keep available?	يَسْأَلُونَكَ مَاذَا يُنْفِقُونَ
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Only “ذَا” (*za*) has been added to “مَا” (*ma*) as in (3) above.

“مَآیَ فِیْهِ” (*maa feeh*): exaggerated.
 “الْمِائَةُ” (*al-mi'ata*): one hundred.

Zamkhashri says it is derived from “مَآیْتُ الْجِلْدَ” (*maa ait-ul-jild*) which means “I spread out the skin”.

2:259	one hundred years	مِائَةُ عَامٍ
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And a hundred is indeed a sizeable number.

Ibn Faris says this root means “hundred” as well as to create chaos in a society.

It is probable that “الْمِائَةُ” (*al-mi'atah*) meant hundred because in those days a man with hundred *deenars* or camels would be considered a rich man or a capitalist type, and would be the cause of conflict or chaos in society, as rich men often are.

Majooj

مَآ جُوجُ

Refer to “يَا جُوجُ” (*Yajooj*) in heading (A-J-J).

M-R-T

ماروت

“الْمَرْتُ” (*al-mert*): a barren desert which has no vegetation.
 “الْمَرْتُ” (*al-mert*): to break {T}.
 “الْمَرْتُ” (*al-mert*) and “الْمَرْتُ” (*al-mert*): to break {T}.
 “مَارُوتُ” (*maaroot*) is a non-Arabic word (2:102). See heading *Haroot*.

M-T-Ain

م ت ع

“مَتَاعُ” (*mat'a*): things that are needed, anything of utility (16:80). Basically it means all those items which are enough for a journey {T}.

Therefore “الْمَتَاعُ” (*al-mata'u*) means a thing from which a little benefit can be had but it is not enduring {M}. “الْمَتَاعُ” (*al-mut'ah*): the things needed in a journey {T}. It also means the life's expenses that a woman gets from the man (her husband) after divorce is also called “مَتَاعُ” (*mut'ah*) {T}. It also means earning to break even.

“الْمَرَأَةُ تُمَتِّعُ صَبِيَّهَا” (*al-mar'atu tumatti-u sabiyyaha*): that woman is breast feeding her child {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to benefit from something for long, and also the profit in which there is an element of pleasure or which has an element of evolution and development. To obtain benefit is common between the two meanings.

The Quran has called the earth as “مَتَاعُ” (*mata*) in (2:36), probably because it is the source of providing the means of sustenance for a man's life. Every man can benefit from it but cannot seize it. It is “سَوَاءٌ لِلنَّاسِ أَلْبَسَ” (*sawa-in lis sa-ileen*) in (41:10), i.e. open for all the needy.

Since there is an element of upkeep in “مَتَاعُ” (*mata*), therefore “الْمَتَاعُ” (*al-mati'u*) means everything which is better and longer lasting than others, which has been developed in a good way. It also means a well woven rope as well as dark red wine {M}.

“مَتَعَ النَّهَارُ” (*mata'un nahaar*): the day progressed.

“مَتَعَ الْحَبْلُ” (*mata’al habl*): the rope became hard and strong.
 “الْتَمَتِيعُ” (*at-tam’ti-u*): to prolong, to extend the age, to habitat. The dictionary has other meanings for it too. From it “مَتَاعُ” (*mata-un*) can be derived which means to give benefit {*M*}.

“أَفَرَأَيْتَ إِنْ مَتَّعْنَاهُمْ سِنِينَ” (*afara’aita inn matta’naahum sineen*) (26:205) have you noted that if they are given years, for benefiting from this life.

“الْمَتْعُ” (*al-mata’u*): secret plan {*T*}.

“أَمَتَّ عَنْهُ” (*amta’a unhu*): he became free from his needs or requirements {*T*}.

M-T-N

م ت ن

“الْمَتْنُ” (*al-matn*): hard, smooth and high land.

“مَتْنُ” (*mat’un*), “يَمْتُنُ” (*yamtun*): he became hard and strong.

“الْتَمَتِينَ” (*at-tamteen*): the ropes of a tent. It also means to peg a tent.

“الْمِتانُ” (*al-mitan*): the space between two pillars.

“الْمَتَانَةُ” (*al-matanah*): intensity and strength, hardness and strength.

“سَيْفٌ مَتِينٌ” (*saifun mateen*): a sword with a strong back.

“تَوْبٌ مَتِينٌ” (*saubun mateen*): strong and hard cloth {*T*}.

The Quran says:

7:183	my plan is very stolid, strong and intense (nobody can break it)	إِنَّ كَيْدِي مَتِينٌ
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As such Allah is also called “الْمَتِينُ” (*al-mateen*) in (51:58). This verse means that His laws are well established in the Universe i.e. He is well established and provides strength to others as well who follow His guidance. Some say that “ذُو الْقُوَّةِ” (*zul-quwwat*) is one whose strength also affects others, and “مَتِينٌ” (*mateen*) is one who is steadfast and stolid in his own personality {*T*}. But I think that “مَتِينٌ” (*mateen*) can mean both things.

Mataa

مَتَّى

“مَتَّى” (*mataa*): “when”.

33:29	When will this promise be fulfilled?	مَتَّى هَذَا الْوَعْدُ
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Sometimes “مَتَّى” (*mataa*) means “then”, where it is conditional.

M-Th-L

م ث ل

“مِثْلُ” (*misal*): like or similar or equal to somebody.

“مَثَلُ” (*masal*): is a description of something which is related to compare it with something.

“مِثَالُ” (*misaal*): the way, style, form, shape or model according to which something is made. It means a pattern according to which something is measured or cut out. It also means example {*L, T, M*}.

“أَمْسَلُ” (*amsal*): better. The feminine is “مُثْلَى” (*musla*).

“الطَّرِيقَةُ الْمُثْلَى” (*at-tareeqal musla*): the way which is according to the truth and justice and which it resembles.

“تَمَثَّلُ” (*tamseel*): picture something.

“تَمَثَّلُ” (*tamassul*): to become like someone.

“إِمْتِثَالُ” (*imtisaal*): to follow someones’ path fully.

“مَثَلُ الرَّجُلِ” (*masalar rajul*): that man stood erected. It also means to hug the ground {*T*}.

“مُثَلَّةٌ” (*muslah*): to kill somebody and amputate the body and distort it {T}.

“مُثَلَّةٌ” (*masulah*) and “مَثَلَةٌ” (*maslah*), plural is “مَثَلَاتٌ” (*masulaat*) means lessons of history or punishments which stand out historically {T} (13:6).

“تَمَثَّلٌ” (*timsaal*): concept. Its plural is “تَمَثِّلٌ” (*tamaseel*).

Taj-ul-Uroos says that the Quran uses “” (*tamaseel*) to mean picture (of events) of the messengers {T}. But the Christians think that “” (*tamaseel*) mean statues, and picture means paintings {T, L, M}.

The Quran says “مَثَلُهُمْ” (*masaluhum*) in (2:17). It means “examples” or “similarities”. When it says “مَثَلٌ” (*misliha*) in (2:106), then it means “which is similar to it”.

Surah *Ar-Raad* says:

13:35	The example of the Jannah which is promised to the righteous is like ...	مَثَلُ الْجَنَّةِ الَّتِي وُعدَ الْمُتَّقُونَ
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Here “مَثَلٌ” (*masal*) means an allegoric description.

Surah *Taha* says:

20:63	The path which is close to the truth, justice, balance, and proportion.	بِطَرِيقَتِكُمُ الْمُثَلَّى
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Aqrabil Muwarid says with reference to **Keys** that here “مَثَلٌ” (*masal*) means the beneficence, i.e. increased and overwhelmed. Thus “أَمَثَلٌ” (*amsal*) came to mean “better” and “overwhelming”. The feminine is “مُثَلَّى” (*musla*). As such “بِطَرِيقَتِكُمُ الْمُثَلَّى” (*bi tareeqatikumul musla*) would mean “a way which is overpowering on other ways”. Every overpowering or strong nation thinks its way or religion is better and overpowering as compared to that of others, no matter how wrong or false that may be.

“أَمَثَلُهُمْ طَرِيقَةً” (*amsaluhum tareeqah*): means a man who is on a way of high quality (30:104).

Surah *An-Nahal* says those people who do not believe in the life of the future have a very weak character.. For them it has been said:

16:60	similitude of evil is applied to those who do not believe in the hereafter; To Allah applies the highest similitude...	مَثَلُ السَّوْءِ وَلِلَّهِ الْمَثَلُ الْأَعْلَى
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Surah *Al-Ambia* calls the idols (or statues) which were worshipped by the nation of *Ibrahim* as “تَمَثِّلٌ” (*tamaseel*) in (21:52). This makes it clear that “تَمَثِّلٌ” (*tamaseel*) means statues. Therefore when in (34:13) it is said that *Suleman* used to have “تَمَثِّلٌ” (*tamaseel*) made then it means statues.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:17	the angel came before <i>Maryam</i> in the shape of a balanced human being	فَأَرْسَلْنَا إِلَيْهَا رُوحَنَا فَتَمَثَّلَ لَهَا بَشَرًا سَوِيًّا
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The likely explanation is that it was a dream, i.e. *Maryam* saw all this in a dream.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says “مُتَلِّهِمْ” (*mislahim*) in (3:12) to mean “double than self”.

The Quran says:

2:23	Whatever we have revealed unto our messenger, if you have any doubts about it, then make and bring one (single) verse like it.	وَأِنْ كُنْتُمْ فِي رَيْبٍ مِّمَّا نَزَّلْنَا عَلَىٰ عَبْدِنَا فَأْتُوا بِسُورَةٍ مِثْلِهِ
2:24	but you will not be able to do that	فَإِنْ لَّمْ تَفْعَلُوا وَلَنْ تَفْعَلُوا...

This challenge has been reiterated at other places too, see (11:13), (10:38).

This challenge has been held out by the Quran to its initial Arab addressees and then has been addressed all times and the entire world, generation after generation but none can take up this challenge. The reason for this is evident from the Quranic guidance which is based on non-human thought process. Human

beings do not think like the Quran and cannot think like it, because they have a free will and desires as a default status. The continuous arousal of desires makes them emotive in thinking and most human beings follow their desires, which only direct them to think for their own good. To counter this default position, individuals need to think hard and overcome their desires and emotions and question the purpose of their life at some point in life. The Quran explains this inner human state in detail and invites us to overcome this default position by studying the Quran using the intellect and reasoning in the light of the presenting evidence from a social set up. The Quranic writing and their meaning and interpretation both are unique because the concepts and realities revealed are beyond human ability to think and reproduce. The human intellect cannot think of these meta-physical facts which are gradually coming to light with the passage of time. According to one **Prof. H.A.R. Gibbs**, the Quran cannot even be translated truly into any language of the world *{Modern Trends in Islam}*.

The truth is that the Quran's style is unique. It is neither poetry nor prose, neither is there any such instance in Arab literature, earlier than the advent of the Quran or later. Therefore one has to concede that the Quran is from God and God alone and is unique. There can be no other example like it.

M-J-D

م ج د

“الْمَجْدُ” (*al-majd*): actually means abundance *{M}*. It is derived from “مَجَدَّتِ الْإِبِلُ” (*majazatilo ibl*) which is used or said when the camels enter a very green grazing land which has fodder in abundance *{R}*.

Ibn Faris says it means to reach the peak in good qualities like kindness and gentleness etc. He says “مَجَدَّتِ الْإِبِلُ” (*majadatil ibl*) means “the camels neared a full stomach”.

“أَمَجَدَنَا فُلَانُنْ” (*amjadana fulanun*): that man gave us so much hospitality that it was not only enough for us but there was some to spare.

“أَمَجَدَ الْعَطَاءَ” (*amjadalata'a*): gave him abundant charity.

“أَمَجَدَ الْإِبِلَ” (*amjadal ibl*): gave camels stomach full of fodder *{T}*.

The Arabs considered largesse as a very good trait and they called “الْمَجْدُ” (*al-majd*) the highest trait *{R}*. Scholars say that “مَجْدُ” (*majd*) and respect are the same and include the trait of forefathers, but the Quran has called Allah as “مَجِيدٌ” (*majeed*) and never “شَرِيفٌ” (*shareef*). This shows that this trait is only personal and has no bearing of the forefathers.

The Quran has said “مَجِيدٌ” (*majeed*) is one of the traits of Allah (85:15, 11:73) i.e. one who gives abundantly whether it be the accoutrements of life or guidance, or one who creates vastness and abundance, or one who takes to extremes. As such he is “حَمِيدٌ” (*hameed*) i.e. one who deserves all praises.

M-J-S

م ج س

“الْمَجُوسِيَّةُ” (*al-majoosia*): an ancient religion which was revived by **Zartasht**. The followers of this religion are called “مَجُوسٌ” (*majoosun*) *{T, M}*. After **Zartasht** died, this religion became distorted. Two forces of good and evil, i.e. **Aharmun** and **Yazdan** were acknowledged. The Quran has mentioned “الْمَجُوسُ” (*al-majoos*) in (22:17) along with the Jews and the Christians. They have not been further introduced by the Quran because in that era (when the Quran was being revealed) the followers of this religion existed and the Arabs were well aware about them. Nowadays they are generally said to be ‘**Parsis**’.

Ibn Faris says that *majoosi* is a Persian word.

M-H-Sd

م ح ص

“الْمَحْصُ” (*al-mahs*): to remove faults of a thing *{R}*.

“مَحَصَّ الذَّهَبَ بِالنَّارِ” (*mahsaz zahaban naar*): melted gold over fire and removed its impurities and purified it {*M*}.

“مَحَصَّ السَّيْفَ” (*mahasas sinaan*): he honed the spear, or made it sparkle {*T*}.

The Quran says:

3:153	so that the it removes the impurities that you your hearts have	وَلِيُمَحِّصَ مَا فِي قُلُوبِكُمْ
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“حَبْلٌ مَحْصٌ” (*hablun mahis*): a rope which has become smooth due to use and thus becomes soft.

“فَرَسٌ مَحْصٌ” (*farsun mahsun*) and “مُمَحَّصٌ” (*mumah’his*): a strong bodied horse {*T*}.

“مَحْصٌ” (*mahsun*): make strong and sturdy.

In Surah *Aal-e-Imran* this word has been used against “مَحْقٌ” (*mahq*) in (3:140).

“مَحْصٌ” (*mahsun*) and “مَحْقٌ” (*mahqun*) both have the element of reducing (impurities or faults), but

“مَحْصٌ” (*mahsun*) has the element of removing or reducing something’s faults or weaknesses and thus making it strong.

“مَحْقٌ” (*mahqun*) has the element of obliterating something. See heading (*M-H-Q*).

M-H-Q

م ح ق

“مَحَقَّةٌ” (*mahaqah*): obliterated it so that nothing remained of it {*T*}.

“الْمَحْقُ” (*al-mahq*): for something to be obliterated entirely so that no part is visible.

“مَحَقَّ الْحَرُّ الشَّيْءَ” (*mahjaqul harrish shaiyi*): the heat burned and destroyed it.

“إِمْتَاحُ النَّبَاتِ” (*imtahaqin nabaat*): the plants dried up because of the intense heat {*T*}.

“الْمَحَقَّةُ” (*al-mahaqahu*): destruction {*T*}.

Raghib says it means to be reduced. *Ibn Faris* says this too.

“الْمَحَاقُ” (*al-mahaq*), “الْمُحَاقُ” (*al-muhaaq*) and “الْمِحَاقُ” (*al-mihaaq*) are the last few nights of the lunar month when the moon is not sighted.

Surah *Al-Baghr* says:

2:276	Allah’s law reduces or destroys the wealth that has been acquired due to interest	يَمْحَقُ اللَّهُ الرِّبَا
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A society which is based on interest can never (ultimately) be successful. Here “يَمْحَقُ” (*yamhaqu*) has come opposite “يُرْبِي” (*yurbi*) which means “to increase”.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says “يَمْحَقُ” (*yamhaqu*) against “يُمَحِّصُ” (*yumah’his*) in (3:140). See heading (*M-H-Sd*).

M-H-L

م ح ل

“الْمَحْلُ” (*al-mahl*): secret plan, scheme, conspiracy, move, intensity, pangs of hunger, drought, for the rain to stop and for land to become parched.

“زَمَانٌ مَاحِلٌ” (*zamanun maahil*): dry time when there is no rain.

“أَرْضٌ مَحِلٌ” (*ardun mahil*): the land where it has not rained in time and due to which it faces drought.

“أَمَحَلَّ الْقَوْمَ” (*amhalal qaum*): that nation faced drought.

“مَاحَلَهُ مَحَالًا” (*maahalahu mihaala*): he treated him as an enemy, competed or fought with him so that it was known as to who is stronger.

“الْمَاحِلُ” (*al-maahil*): an opponent who quarrels {*T, R, M*}.

About Allah the Quran says:

13:13	who holds accountability strictly	هُوَ شَدِيدُ الْحَالِ
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In other words it means “a strict punisher”, or “someone who holds accountability with strictness”, or “whose consequential law is very strong and who compiles results of deeds honestly and strictly” and “who makes no concessions”. There is an element of strength here with strictness.

“مَحْلِي يَا فُلَانُ” (*mah hilni ya fulaan*): O man, give me strength $\{T, R, M\}$.

Some say that “مِحَالٌ” (*mighalun*) is actually derived from “حَوْلٌ” (*hawl*) and “حِيلَةٌ” (*heelah*) and the “م” (*m*) is additional. See (*H-W-L*).

“مَحَنٌ” (*mahn*) actually means to lash.

“الْمِحْنَةُ” (*al-mihnatu*) is a noun and the plural is “مِحَنٌ” (*mihan*), i.e. those travails which are meant as tests.

“مَحَنُ الْبَاءِ رَمَحْنَاهُ” (*mahanal bi'ra mahna*): he cleaned the well by taking out the mud {T}.

“مَحَنَ الْأَدِيمَ” (*mahanal adeem*): he softened the leather, or pared it and made it clean, or he stretched the leather and made it expand.

“مَحَنَ الْفِضَّةَ” (*mahamal fizzaah*): he purified the silver by heating it over the fire and cleansed it {T}.

The Quran says:

49:3	These are the people whose hearts Allah has cleansed and purified to receive <i>taqwa</i>	أُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ افْتَحَنَ اللَّهُ قُلُوبَهُمْ لِلتَّقْوَى
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“إِمْتِحَانٌ” (*imtihaan*): to find out someone's internal situation or to test him.

Surah *Al-Mumtahanah* says:

60:10	O you who believe! When <i>momin</i> women come to you after question them about their matters	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِذَا جَاءَكُمُ الْمُؤْمِنَاتُ مُهَاجِرَاتٍ فَامْتَحِنُوهُنَّ
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“مَحَاهُ” (*mahaahu*), “يَمْحُوهُ” (*yamhuhu*), “مَحَوَّ” (*mahwa*): he obliterated, destroyed, ended his signs or influence. It also means rain which removes the signs of drought.

“مَحَا الصُّبْحُ اللَّيْلَ” (*mahas subhul lail*): the day replaced the night by dawning.

“الْمَحْوَةُ” (*al-mahv*): the mark that is seen in the moon.

Ibn Faris says it means to take something away and make it disappear.

The Quran has used “مَحَوَّ” (*mahv*) against “تُبَاتٌ” (*isbaat*):

13:39	According to His law, Allah destroys that which is not needed and keeps that which is necessary	يَمْحُو اللَّهُ مَا يَشَاءُ وَيُثَبِّتُ
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It means that He destroys that which has destructive results and gives room to that which has constructive results (42:24) i.e. that which is beneficial for mankind (13:17). This law of requital can be seen operating in every part of the universe and it is also working among nations. That is, the existence of the beneficial that which is good or beneficial for mankind exists (13:17).

It will be noted that the law of survival or existence of that which beneficial for mankind is much superior than what the Darwinian observed in the physical evolution i.e. the Survival of the Fittest. The former is the right principle for the mankind to follow in this life:

13:17	Only that thing is allowed to exist on this earth which is beneficial to mankind	وَأَمَّا مَا يَنْفَعُ النَّاسَ فَيَمْكُثُ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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In other words, the concept or ideology which is beneficial to the entire mankind and not to any particular group, party, nation or country is allowed, so that all men of the world can benefited from it.

“مَخَّرَ” (*makhr*): to split, or to tear asunder {*M, F*}.

“مَخَرَّتِ السَّفِينَةُ” (*makharatis safeenah*): the boat parted the water and proceeded {*T*}.

“مَخَرَّ السَّابِحُ” (*makharas saabi'u*): the swimmer parted the water with both hands {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

16:14	And you see the boat ploughing through it	وَتَرَى الْفُلَ مَاجِرًا فِيهِ
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Here “مَاجِرًا” (*mawakhir*) is the plural of “مَاجِرَةٌ” (*maakhirah*) which means that which splits the body of water to proceed (e.g. like boats).

“مَخَضَ اللَّبَنُ” (*makhzal laban*): churned the milk (or curd).

“مَخَضَ الشَّيْءُ مَخْضًا” (*makhazash shaiyi makhza*): to move something with force, or to move in a way as is done while churning milk.

“تَمَخَضَ الْوَلَدُ” (*tamakh khazal wald*): the child moved in such a way in the pregnant woman's womb that it indicated that the time of birth was near.

“أَلْمَاخِضُ” (*al-maakhiz*): the pregnant woman whose time to give birth is near.

“مَخَضَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ” (*makhzatil mar'ah*): the woman started having labour pains {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Maryam* says “أَلْمَخَاضُ” (*al-makhaas*) means labour pains (19:23).

“مَدَّ” (*mudd*): to pull something lengthwise or to be joined with something lengthwise.

“مَدَّ” (*mudd*): flood, because in it water seems to extend for a long distance. It also means “to increase”.

“مَدُّ الْبَحْرِ” (*muddul bahr*): tide of the sea.

“مَدَّ نَظْرَهُ إِلَيْهِ” (*mudda nazarahu ilaih*): peeped at him, lifted his eyes towards him.

“مَدَّ” (*mudd*) and “إِمْدَادٌ” (*imdaad*) also means to concede time.

“مَدِيدٌ” (*madeed*): a long or extended thing.

“مِدَادٌ” (*midaad*): ink, because it keeps coming continuously from a pen and the ink which comes later mixes with the former ink.

“مَدَّ” (*mudd*) also means to help {*T, M*}.

Some scholars think that “مَدَّ” (*mudd*) is mostly used for things that are bad and “إِمْدَادٌ” (*imdaad*) for things which are good {*R*}.

“مَادَّةٌ” (*maaddah*): anything that increases another thing {*T, M*}.

Scholars say it also means “الزِّيَادَةُ الْمُتَّصِلَةُ” (*az ziyaadaa tul muttasilah*), that is “anything which increases with its elements”. This word is used to mean “matter”. The Quran has not used this word.

The Quran says:

27:36	Will you increase me	أَتَزِيدُونَنِي
15:88	do not increase your eyes towards it (do not see greedily at things)	لَا تَمْدُدْ عَيْنَيْكَ إِلَىٰ مَا مَتَّعَنَا
18:109	Ink to spread the words	مِدَادًا لِكَلِمَاتٍ
56:30	And the error extended	وَوَيْلٌ مِّمَّا دُوِّرَ
17:20	Everything that We extended	كُلًّا مَبْدُودٍ
17:6	And we reinforced you	وَأَمْدَدْنَاكُمْ
19:74	An extension	مَدًّا
19:79	From an extensive punishment	مِنَ الْعَذَابِ مَدًّا
13:3	Allah is one who has spread out the earth	وَهُوَ الَّذِي مَدَّ الْأَرْضَ
2:15	And we prolonged their term	وَبَدَّلْنَاهُمْ فِي طُعْيَانِهِمْ
18:109	As an increased supplement	بِمِثْلِهِ مَدْدًا

M-D-N

م د ن

“مَدَنَ بِالْمَكَانِ” (*madna bil makaan*): he stayed at that place.

“الْمَدِينَةُ” (*al-madinah*): big town (36:20). The plural is “مَدَائِنُ” (*mada'een*) which means “many cities” as in (7:111). It also means “fort”. Some say that it has been derived from “دِينٌ” (*deen*). See heading (**D-Y-N**).

“مَدَائِنُ” (*mada-in*) was the name of a big city in *Persia* near *Baghdad*.

“مَدْيَنُ” (*madyanu*) was the name of *Shoaib's* area {*T, M, R*} as it says in (7:85).

“تَمَدَّنَ الرَّجُلُ” (*tamadyanar rajul*): the man became well-to-do.

“تَمَدَّنَ الرَّجُلُ” (*tamaddanar rajul*): he adopted the ways of the city dwellers and was no more uncouth and became civilized.

“مَدَّنْتُ مَدِينَةً” (*maddantu madinah*): I built a city i.e. populated it {*T*}.

Madyan

مَدْيَنُ

The nation towards whom *Shoaib* was sent as a messenger (7:85), or the area towards which *Moosa* went (28:22). For details see heading “*Shoaib*” and heading *Moosa*.

M-R-A

م ر ا

“الْمَرْءُ” (*al-mar'oo*), “الْمُرءُ” (*al-mur'oo*), “الْمِرءُ” (*al-mir'oo*), and “اُمُرُو” (*oomroo*): human being or man.

“الْمَرْأَةُ” (*al-mar'atu*) and “الْإِمْرَأَةُ” (*al-imra'atu*) means woman.

“مُرُوَّةٌ” (*murua'tun*): humanity, manliness.

“مَرِيءُ الطَّعَامِ مَرَاءَةٌ” (*mari at-tu'aamu muru'ah*): the food became delicious.

“هَنِيئٌ” (*haniyun*): delicious food.

“مَرِيئَةٌ مَرِيئَةٌ” (*marri'un*): food which has a fine result (4:4).

“مَرْجُ” (*marj*): to mix together, or to merge. *Raghib* says “الْمُرُوجُ” (*al-muruj*) also has this meaning.
 “الْمَرْجُ” (*al-maraj*): tribulations. It also means chaos and disharmony {*T, R*}.

Surah *Al-Qaf* says that these people deny the truth:

50:5	They are in a complex situation. They are confused and troubled. They are in confusion which leads to disbelief.	فَهُمْ فِي أَمْرٍ مُّزِجٍ
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“الْمَارِجُ” (*al-maarij*): a mixed thing, high and intense flame {*T, R*}, but “مَرْجُ” (*marj*) also means to make free. Therefore “الْمَارِجُ” (*al-maarij*) would mean a flame of fire with no obstruction in front.

Surah *Al-Rahman* says:

55:15	Mixed flame or flaring flame of fire	مِنْ مَّارِجٍ مِنْ نَّارٍ
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“الْمَرْجُ” (*al-marj*) also means vast grazing land and open space where the animals graze freely probably because in grazing freely the animals mingle together {*T, R*}.

“الْمَرْجَاهَا” (*amrajahaa*): he left animals to graze freely.

“الْمَرْجُ” (*al-maraj*): camels which are grazing freely without anyone shepherding them.

“الْمَرْجُ” (*al-marj*): to issue, and to let roam free {*T, R*}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings are to come and go and be troubled.

The Quran says “مَرْجَ الْبَحْرَيْنِ” (*maraj al-bahrain*) in (25: 53) and (55:19), which means that He has made two rivers which flow side by side – two waters which do not mix due to their different densities e.g. river water and sea water as in an estuary.

“الْمَرْحُ” (*al-marah*): the sort of happiness in which due to intensity a man becomes out of bounds. It also means to preen.

“فَرْسٌ مِمْرَحٌ” (*farsan mimrah*): a horse which is drunk with its own power.

“قَوْسٌ مَرْوُوحٌ” (*qausan marooh*): strongly strung bow which shoots arrows very fast {*T, R, M*}.

The Quran says:

17:37	Do not walk preening on the earth	وَلَا تَمْشِ فِي الْأَرْضِ مَرَحًا
40:75	These people pride themselves or preen because of no constructive work	بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَفْرَحُونَ فِي الْأَرْضِ بِغَيْرِ الْحَقِّ وَبِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَمْرَحُونَ
3:187	They want praise for good work which they have not done.	وَيُحِبُّونَ أَنْ يُحْمَدُوا بِمَا لَمْ يَفْعَلُوا

“مَرَدٌ” (*marad*), “يَمْرُدُ” (*yamrud*): to rebel.

“مَرَدٌ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*marada alash shaiyi*): he became habitual to it, he kept on performing it.

“تَمَرُّدٌ” (*tamarrud*): to become fond of and be habitual of {*T*}.

The Quran says:

9:101	they have become habitual of hypocrisy	مَرَدُّوا عَلَى النَّفَاقِ
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“الْمَرْدَاءُ” (*al-marda'o*): a woman who has no hair on her head {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to shave off the hair at the top of something.

“الْأَمْرَدُ” (*al-amradu*) is a young man who has not grown a beard yet. The Quran has called the shaitaan as “مَرِيدٌ” (*mareed*) in 4:117. According to the earlier meaning it would mean “rebellious”.
“الْمَرِيدُ” (*al-mareed*): a date immersed in milk to soften it.

Raghib says it has been derived from “شَجَرَةٌ مَرْدَاءٌ” (*shajaratun marda'o*) which means a tree which has no leaves. This would mean he, who has been deprived of all good things. These meanings are the same as that of “رَجِيمٌ” (*rajeem*) and “لَعِينٌ” (*la-een*). See heading (**R-J-M**) and (**L-Ain-N**).

Ismaee says it means anything which is rubbed till it softens up.

The Quran says “صَرَحٌ مُمَرَّدٌ” (*sarhun mu arrad*) in 27:44 which means “smooth” or “polished”.

Ibn Faris says it also means a tall building.

“الْتَمَرِيدُ فِي الْبِنَائِ” (*at-tamreed fil binaa'i*) means to polish and plaster a building, or to plaster it.
“الْمَارِدُ” (*al-maarid*) means high, rebel, devoid of goodness {T} (37:7).

M-R-R

م ر ر

“مَرَّةً” (*marrah*), “مَرَّيْهِ” (*marrabihi*), “مَرَّعَلَيْهِ” (*marra alaihi*): went past him, or went close by him.

“الْمَرَّةُ” (*al-marrah*): once.

“مَرَّتَانِ” (*marrataan*): twice.

“فِي كُلِّ مَرَّةٍ” (*fi kulli marrah*): every time.

“أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ” (*awwala marrah*): first time.

“الْمُرُّ” (*al-murru*): bitter {T}.

“إِسْتَمَرَّ الشَّيْءُ” (*istamarrash shaiyi*): the thing remained forever, remained continuously, proceeded on the same path {M}.

“سِحْرٌ مُسْتَمِرٌّ” (*sihrun mustamirr*) in (54:3) means the same as “إِفْكٌ قَدِيمٌ” (*ifkun qadeem*) in (46:11), i.e. “same old lies”.

Surah **Al-Baghr** says:

2:229	Divorce can only be given twice	الطَّلَاقُ مَرَّتَانِ
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This is generally taken to mean that if a man says “طلاق” (*talaaq*) twice or announces it for two months consecutively then it does not mean that the “طلاق” (*talaaq*) has been effective or taken place, but can be reverted. However if a man says it thrice then the matter is decided. Thereafter if these (former) wife and husband want to re-wed, then it is necessary for the woman to wed another man first and have conjugal relations. This is called **halalah** or **tehleel**. This concept and the method of divorce or “طلاق” (*talaaq*) is against the Quran. According to the Quran there is a defined process for divorce or “طلاق” (*talaaq*). First try for mutual understanding, then an effort at reconciliation through their advocates or arbitrators must take place. Then a decision through the court must be issued. If matters reach this stage and there appears no chance for reconciliation then the man and woman can separate. This is the process of “طلاق” (*talaaq*) as explained in the Quran. Even after this if the man and woman want, they can re-wed, but this can happen only twice in the lives of this couple. If there is a need for divorce for third time in their lives, then these two cannot remarry each other. It is another matter if the woman weds another man and becomes a widow or divorcee, she can remarry the same man again (which is very unlikely in a woman's lifetime). This is what the Quran means when it says “الطَّلَاقُ مَرَّتَانِ” (*at-talaaqu marrataan*). Until two persons are freed from wedlock, they cannot be said to be divorced. Therefore “الطَّلَاقُ مَرَّتَانِ” (*at-talaaqu marrataan*) clearly means that freedom from wedlock can be gained only twice within which one can revert. The third time one gets divorced, he or she cannot revert to the same individual.

“الْمَرُّ” (*al-marru*) also means rope.
 “أَمَرْتُ الْحَبْلَ” (*amrartul habl*): I twined the rope.
 “سَتَمَرَمِرُهُ” (*istamarra mariruh*): his intent was strengthened.
 “اِسْتَمَرَّ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*istamarra bish shaiyi*): he became capable of lifting the thing.

The Arabs say “أَرَجَى الْعُلَمَانِ الَّذِي يَبْدَأُ بِحُمْقٍ ثُمَّ يَسْتَمِرُّ” (*arjal ghilmaanil lazi yabda-oo bihumqin summa yastamirr*) which means that the most promising lad is one who acts foolishly in the beginning but rectifies later. Thus “الْمِرَّةُ” (*al-mirrah*) means moral strength, intensity and cleverness {T}.

Al-Ashqaaq says that “مِرَّةُ الْإِنْسَانِ” (*mirratu insaani*) means the strength of a man.

Surah *Al-Qamar* says:

54:16	In a time of intensity (a time which is continuously detrimental)	فِي يَوْمٍ نَحْسٍ مُّسْتَمِرٍّ
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In surah *Al-Airaaf* the words “فَمَرَّتْ بِهِ” (*famartrat bihi*) mean to feel harshness or intensity (7:189).

Surah *An-Najam* calls Allah “ذُو مِرَّةٍ” (*zumirrah*) in (53:6). It can mean the One who possesses power and wisdom and “One whose intentions are firm and schemes are strong”.

And also one who possesses (is the Sustainer) of the many paths of life. Because “مُرُورٌ” (*muroor*) means to pass by, *Muheet* says “مِرَّةٌ” (*mirrah*) means a condition which one follows constantly. As such it would mean “the laws of Allah which never undergo change”.

M-R-Zd م ر ض

“مَرَضٌ” (*maraz*): for imbalance to be created so that some sort of weakness, or decrease in strength takes place.
 “شَمْسٌ مَرِيضَةٌ” (*shamsun mareezah*): the sun when its light has dimmed due to dust, etc.
 “أَرْضٌ مَرِيضَةٌ” (*ardun mareezah*): such land which is weak in strength, or which gives little produce. It also means a land where there is lack of peace or there is chaos.
 “مَرَاضٍ” (*marazun*): also means darkness or doubt {T}.

The Quran uses “مَرَضٌ” (*marazun*) against “شِفَاءٌ” (*shifa'un*) in (26:80). Here it means bodily disease. “فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ مَرَضٌ” (*fi qulubihim maraz*) has been used in (2:10) where it means psychological disorder. As such whether it is bodily disease or psychological confusion or disorder, the word “مَرَضٌ” (*marazun*) has been used.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says “فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ مَرَضٌ” (*fi qulubihim marazun*) in (2:10) to those who pursue their emotive desires or vested interests and labels this kind of mentality as a sickness. It is a kind of disease of the psyche or mind about which human knowledge was unaware in the era before the 20th century.

The Quran says about itself:

10:57	it has the cure and treatment for the mind.	شِفَاءٌ لِّمَا فِي الصُّدُورِ
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If this disease is not treated with the revelation then this disease increases at its own with time (2:10). The Quran presents a very simple and effective solution in creating a balance in human thinking when the guidance is followed within the domain of the permanent values as explained.

“صَفَا” (*safa*) and “مَرْوَة” (*marwah*) are two hills outside the *Masjid-i-Haraam* in *Mecca*. “صَفَا” (*safa*) which is the plural for “صَفَاة” (*safah*), means white stones or rocks and “مَرْوَة” (*marwah*) means white pebbles. With regard to *Hajj*, they are among the “مِنْ شَعَائِرِ اللَّهِ” (*sha'a'iri Allah*) (2:158).

“شَعَائِر” (*sha'a'ir*) are the symbols, in ceremonies, of a state or system, for example, the flag may be the “شَعَائِر” (*sha'a'ir*) of some state. The respect for the flag means respect for that state. The things proclaimed to be “شَعَائِرِ اللَّهِ” (*sha'a'irillah*) are those which are meant to represent the Islamic state and the respect of which is actually the respect for the system of Allah. These symbols have no more significance other than that. See heading (*Sh-Ain-T*).

M-R-Y

م ر ي

“مَرَى النَّاقَةَ يَمْرِيهَا مَرِيًا” (*maran naaqatah yamriha marya*): to caress the teats of a she-camel to induce it to produce milk.

“الْمَرِيَّةُ” (*al-miryah*), “الْمَرِيَّةُ” (*al-maryah*): the milk which is obtained in this way. This led to the word meaning to find out about something with effort and difficulty.

“مَرِيَّةُ الْفَرَسِ” (*miryatul fars*): the walk that a horse adopts after being coerced with a whip, etc. {*T*} “مَرِيَّةُ” (*miryah*) therefore came to mean tribulation in something. It also means doubt and quarrel.

Raghib says these are its meanings and expression of doubt is especially related to this word {*R*}.

Manawai says “مَرِيَّةُ” (*mira'a*) means to interject with a sarcastic remark and it is done only to belittle.

Fraa says “تَتَمَارَى” (*tatamaara*): to treat as a lie {*R*}.

“إِمْتَرَى فِيهِ” (*imtara feehi*), “تَمَارَى” (*tamari*): to doubt.

The Quran says:

42:18	those who are in doubt or confusion about that <i>saa'at</i> (time for the manifestation of results)	إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يُتَارُونَ فِي السَّاعَةِ
18:22	do not quarrel with them about it	فَلَا تُمَارِ فِيهِمْ
2:147	do not be one of the doubters and the confused	فَلَا تَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْمُتَمَرِّينَ

Maryam

مريم

Maryam is a Syrian word which means high breed or rank. Some say that one who says something very strange is called “يَا مَرِيْمَ” (*ya maryam*) by the Arabs.

“الْمَرِيْمَ مِنَ النِّسَاءِ” (*al-maryamu minan nisa'i*) means a woman who likes to be friendly with men but shuns objectionable or execrable acts {*T, M*}.

The Quran has said that *Isa's* (Jesus') mother was called *Maryam*. She has been called “إِمْرَأَتُ عِمْرَانَ” (*imra'atu imran*) in (3:34) which means the “wife or woman of Imran”.

Surah *Maryam* says in (19:28) that her people called her “أُخْتُ بُرُونٍ” (*ya ukhta haroon*) which means “*Haroon's* sister” which could have two meanings. One that her brother's name was *Haroon* and secondly that she was so called in respect of her forefather, the brother of *Moosa*.

Surah *At-Tahreem* calls her “إِبْنَتُ عِمْرَانَ” (*ibna'ata imran*) in (66:12). Before her birth, her mother had pledged her to the Holy place of the Jews. Hence after her birth she was handed over for the service of this Jewish temple (3:35-36). For details see heading (*H-R-R*).

Jesus has generally been referred as “ابن مريم” (*Ibn Maryam*) or “the son of *Maryam*” in the Quran.

Renaan in his book “*Life of Jesus*” writes that He (Jesus) belonged to the common people. His father Yusuf, and mother *Maryam* both belonged to a poor family and handicraft was their profession. His father died early and thereafter *Maryam* was the head of the family. That is why when someone wanted to single out Jesus from others of the same name, he was called Jesus son of *Maryam*. Details about *Maryam*’s life can be seen in the book titled “*Shola’i’Mastoor*”.

M-Z-J م ز ج

“الْمَزْجُ” (*al-mazj*): to mix.

“مَزَجَ الشَّرَابَ بِالمَاءِ” (*majash sharaba bil maa’i*): he mixed water with the wine.

“مِزَاجٌ” (*mizaaj*): that thing which is mixed with wine.

“مِزَاجُ الْخَمْرِ كَافُورٌ” (*mizaajal khamri kafoor*): that wine smells like *kafoor* (a substance which reduces the effect of heat and brings coolness) {*M*}.

“مِزَاجٌ” (*mizaaj*): every ingredient of a mixture.

The Quran says about *momineen*:

76:5	they drink from a cup which has a tinge of <i>kafoor</i>	يَشْرَبُونَ مِنْ كَأْسٍ كَانَ مِزَاجُهَا كَافُورًا
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The first rank of an organized group imposes self-discipline on itself, and then they endeavour together in the establishment of *Deen*. For this it is said:

76:17	They drink from a cup which has a tinge of <i>zanjabeel</i>	وَيُسْقَوْنَ فِيهَا كَأْسًا كَانَ مِزَاجُهَا زَنْجَبِيلًا
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“زَنْجَبِيلٌ” (*zanjabeel*) is a herb whose effect is to produce heat. Both these stages are necessary for this group. Or it means that “they deal with their ilk softly and are harsh against their enemy”

48:29	Firm against the unbelievers and merciful among themselves	أَشِدَّاءُ عَلَى الْكُفَّارِ رُحَمَاءُ بَيْنَهُمْ
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By creating balance between these opposing forces, hot and cold, the character of the *momineens* is developed. This is what is said as reflecting the “الْأَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَى” (*asma-ul hasana*) or “the attributes of Allah”, i.e. to reflect these attributes in oneself with a particular balance and proportion.

M-Z-Q م ز ق

“مَزَقَهُ” (*mazaqah*), “يَمْزِقُهُ” (*yamziquh*): he tore it or drilled a hole in it.

“فَتَمَزَّقَ” (*fatamazzaq*): so it tore open and was torn to pieces.

“الْمِزَقُ” (*al-mizq*): the pieces of a torn cloth etc.

“تَمَزَّقَ الْقَوْمُ” (*tamazzaqal qaum*): that nation became fissiparous and disintegrated {*T*}.

The Quran says:

34:7	When you will become disintegrated	إِذَا مُتَقَشَّعًا كُلَّ مَمَرٍّ
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This can encompass both the weakness and disintegration of a nation or one’s physical disintegration after death.

“الْمُزْنُ” (*al-muzn*): the white, bright cloud which has rain water in it.

“مُزْنَةٌ” (*muznah*): a piece of such cloud which has rain water in it {T}.

“فُلَانٌ يَتَمَزَّنُ” (*fulanun yatamazzan*): that man is like a cloud, i.e. is a big philanthropist {R}.

The Quran says about water:

56:69	Is it you who bring it down from the clouds?	ءَ أَنْتُمْ أَنْزَلْتُمُوهُ مِنَ الْمُزْنِ
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In other words, all sustenance is from God only.

“الْمَسْحُ” (*al-masah*): to wipe, or to cleanse something that has been soiled with hand.

“مَسَحْتُ رَأْسِي مِنَ الْمَاءِ وَجَبِينِي مِنَ الرِّشْحِ” (*masahtu raasi minal ma'i wajabeeni minar rash*): I wiped the water from my head and the sweat from my forehead.

Abu Zaid says that in Arabic “مَسَحَ” (*masah*) also means to wet or wash, i.e. to cleanse with water.

“مَسَحْتُ يَدِي بِالْمَاءِ” (*masahtul yaadi bil ma'i*): I took a bath {T}.

Ibn Faris says “مَسَحْتُهُ بِيَدِي” (*masahtuhu biyadi*) means “he wiped his hand over his head”.

Surah *Saad* says about *Suleman* that when his horse came in front of him:

38:33	Then he caressed their calves and necks (like riders tend to do over the horses they ride)	فَطَفِقَ مَسْحًا بِالسُّوقِ وَالْأَعْنَاقِ
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“الْمَسْحُ” (*al-masah*), “الْمِسَاحَةُ” (*al-misaahah*): to measure.

“مَسَحَ الْأَرْضَ” (*masahal ard*): he measured the ground or land, or surveyed it {T}.

“الْمِشْخُ” (*al-mish*): path.

“الْمَسِيحُ” (*al-maseeh*): a man who walks too much or is a big traveller {T}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings are to spread something out and to make something traverse some path.

Isa (Jesus) has also been called “مَسِيحٌ” (*maseeh*) in (3:44). *Qamoos* has written out fifty instances of this in *Kitaabil Ashqaaq* {T}. One of them is, and *Raghib* has supported it too, that since Jesus used to walk a lot, he was called “مَسِيحٌ” (*maseeh*).

Raghib also says that in those days there were many people who used to roam about and were called “مَشَاعِينَ” (*masha'een*) or “سَيَّاحِينَ” (*sayyaheen*), and Jesus used to do likewise, hence he was called “مَسِيحٌ” (*maseeh*).

The name of the sect was *Essenees*, for details, see the book titled “*Shola-i-Mastoor*” where *Isa* has been discussed.

Muheet says that kings and astrologers were anointed in those days and since *Isa* too was anointed, he was called “مَسِيحٌ” (*maseeh*) or the *Anointed* one {M} see also heading where you will find that “مَسِيحٌ” (*maseeh*) is a non-Arabic word.

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says that when you rise for the “صَلَاةُ” (*salaat*) then:

5:6	wash your faces and hands up to the elbows	فَاغْسِلُوا وُجُوهَكُمْ وَأَيْدِيَكُمْ إِلَى الْمَرَافِقِ
5:6	And wipe your foreheads	وَامْسَحُوا بِرُءُوسِكُمْ

Here “وَأَمْسَحُوا” (*wamsah*) has appeared separately with “فَاغْسِلُوا” (*faghsilu*), therefore it won’t mean “to wash” but just “wipe”.

Further ahead it is said that if you are ill, or traveling, or have come from the loo or you have been copulating or touching women:

5:6	then go for the clean soil	فَتَيَمَّمُوا صَعِيدًا طَيِّبًا
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The indication is that you must wash whatever part of the body that has been soiled. This part must be cleansed with dust. In addition you must wipe your hands and face with it.

In performing abolition one cleans hands and feet, but it also brings about a psychological change which is essential before performing any task. In the absence of water the purpose of washing hands and feet cannot be fulfilled but with “تَيَمَّمَ” (*tayammum*) that is, performing abolition with dust does make us psychologically ready for the “صَلَاةَ” (*salaat*).

M-S-Kh م س خ

“الْمَسْكُحُ” (*al-maskh*): to change somebody’s form or distort it, that is, make it uglier than it was before {*T, R, M*}.

The act of deterioration continues in the body as well as in morals too: but in both cases, it entails ugliness.

“الْمَسِيخُ مِنَ النَّاسِ” (*al-maseekh unin naas*): a man who has no good points or who is weak and foolish.

“لَحْمٌ مَسِيخٌ” (*lahmun maseekh*): meat which has no taste {*T, M, R, F*}.

“طَعَامٌ مَسِيخٌ” (*tu’aamun maseekh*): food, which has no salt, or color and has no taste.

“إِنْسِمَاخُ حَمَاءَةِ الْفَرَسِ” (*insimakhul hamaatil fars*): for the horse leg muscle to become weak.

The Quran says:

36:67	we will make them weak and deprived despite their being powerful (their strength will turn to weakness)	لَمَسْخُفُهُمْ عَلَى مَكَائِهِمْ
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M-S-D م س د

“الْمَسْدُ” (*al-masd*): to twist.

“مَسَدَ الْحَبْلِ” (*masadal hab*): he twisted the rope.

“الْمَسْدُ” (*al-masad*): the strands of the date palm which are twisted together to make a rope, or a rope made in this way {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

111:5	a rope made of date palm twine	حَبْلٍ مَسَدٍ
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The meaning here is of firm grip of the Law of Requital which is applicable to all for all times without any exception.

“مَسَّ” (*muss*): to touch, or to reach something {*T, R*}.

Raghib says that “مَسَّ” (*muss*) is of the same meaning as “لَمَسَ” (*lams*). The only difference is that “لَمَسَ” (*lams*) also means to search and grope although it is not necessary to find the thing that is being searched for against “مَسَّ” (*muss*) which is used when that thing has also being comprehended.

The initial effect of a thing is also called “مَسَّ” (*muss*).

“وَجَدَ فُلَانٌ مَسَّ الْخُمَى” (*wajad fulanun mussal humma*): he felt the initial feeling of fever.

“لَمْ يَجِدْ مَسًّا مِنَ النَّاصِبِ” (*lum yajid massan minan nasab*): he did not feel any tiredness at all, or anything that befalls and any pain is called “مَسَّ” (*muss*). Figuratively it also means craziness {*T, R*}.

“الْتَمَسَ” (*at-tamaas*): to mutually touch one another. Indirectly or as a passing reference it also refers to copulation {*T, R*} (58:3).

For copulation “مَسَّ” (*muss*) and “مَاسَّ” (*maas*) are used as well {*T, M*}. For copulation “تَمَسَّوْهُنَّ” (*tamassuhun*) has been used in (2:236).

Surah **Al-Taha** says the **Samri** who had created the golden calf for the **Bani-Israeel** was punished:

20:97	he was made to say “I did not touch anyone so nobody should touch me” { <i>T</i> }	أَنْ تَقُولَ لَا مَسَّاسَ
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He was ostracized and had become an untouchable, i.e. all had severed social relations with him.

Muheet says “لَمَسَ” (*lams*) particularly means “to touch with hand” and “مَسَّ” (*muss*) is a common touch, i.e. to touch with a hand as well as with any part of the body.

The Quran says:

56:79	except those who are pure in character and in thought	لَا يَمَسُّهُ إِلَّا الْمُطَهَّرُونَ
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Here by touching the Quran does not mean only touching it but to be aware of its truths {*T, M*}. This meaning is also supported by **Ruuh-ul-Mu'aani**. Actually in order to grasp the message of the Quran, purity of the mind and heart are essential. A man who approaches it with pre-conceived non-Quranic thoughts, will never comprehend its real meaning. The heart or mind which is full of non-Quranic thoughts, beliefs, and ideas can never be illuminated with the light of the Quran. Only he who comes to the Quran with an open mind when his mind is searching for the truth can benefit from it. Only the pure one can therefore touch or benefit from it.

“الْمَسْكُ” (*al-musk*): skin which encompasses bones and flesh, and skin used for making water bags.

“مَسَكَ بِهِ” (*masaka bihi*), “أَمَسَكَ” (*amsak*), “تَمَسَكَ” (*tamasak*), “اسْتَمَسَكَ” (*istamsak*), “تَمَسَّكَ” (*tamassak*), “مَسَّكَ” (*massak*) mean to catch somebody, or to stick to something {*T, M*}.

“الْإِمْسَاكُ” (*al-imsaak*): to be miserly {*M*}.

“الْمِسْكُ” (*al-misk*), “مُسْكُ” (*musk*): a kind of perfume taken from the navel of the deer because it is created from the blood that stops in the deer’s navel {*T, M*}.

In Surah **Al-Baqrah**, “إِمْسَاكُ” (*imsak*) has been used against “تَسْرِيعُ” (*tasreeh*) (2:229). In other words, it means “to keep within wedlock”.

In Surah **Bani Israeel** it has been used against “إِنْفَاقُ” (*infuaq*) in (17:100).

In Surah *Al-Faatir* it has come against “فَتَحَ” (*fatah*) which means to disclose something (35:2). In (35:41) it has come against “زَالِ” (*zaal*) which means “for something to move away from its place”.

In Surah *Saad* verse (38:39), it has been used against “مَنَّ” (*mann*) which means miserliness.

Surah *Al-Tatfeef* says about the “wine” of *jannat*:

83:26	it has been sealed with <i>mushk</i> .	حَتْمُهُ مِسْكٌ
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Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says about hunting animals:

5:4	eat the prey they hold	فَكُلُوا مِمَّا أَفْسَكْنَ عَلَيْكُمْ
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M-S-W/Y م س و ی

“الْمَسَاءُ” (*al-masa'u*): evening time. It is the opposite of “صَبَاحٌ” (*sabah*) which means morning.
 “مَسَاكَ فُلَانٌ وَ أَمْسَى وَ مَسَى” (*masaaka fulanun wa amsa wa massa*): that man promised you but delayed in fulfilling his promise.
 “مَسَاكَكَ اللَّهُ بِالْخَيْرِ” (*massakal laahul bilk khair*): may Allah grant you a good evening.
 “الْمُسَى” (*al-mis'u*) “الْمُسَى” (*al-mis'u*): evening time {M}.
 “أَمْسَى” (*amsa*): he entered the evening time.

Ibnul Qatwiyah says that “الْمَسَاءُ” (*al-masa'u*) is the time between *asar* and *maghrib* prayers.

Muhammed says that “الْمَسَاءُ” (*al-masa'u*) is used for *two* timings, as when the sun starts setting and second when it has set {M}. The Arabs figuratively use “مَسَاءُ” (*masa'u*) to mean destruction and the word “صَبَاحٌ” (*sabah*) for pleasantness {M}.

The Quran says:

30:17	So it is purity for Allah when you enter the evening and when you do it in the morning	فَسُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ حِينَ تُمْسُونَ وَحِينَ تُصْبِحُونَ
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This is the traditional translation.

The meaning of the above verse is that Allah is above time. Morning and evening are distinctions for you, while Allah is above these limitations.

Maseeh مَسِيحٌ

“مَسِيحٌ” (*maseeh*) is another name for *Isa* (Jesus), as used in (3:44). For details see heading (*M-S-He*) and *Isa*. His life details can be seen in the book titled *Shola-e-Mastoor*.

M-Sh-J م ش ج

“مَشَجَ بَيْنَهُمَا” (*mashaja bainahuma*): he mixed these two together {T, R}. *Ibn Faris* too says this is the basic meaning.
 “شَيْءٌ مَشِيجٌ” (*shaiyun masheejun*) and “مَشِجٌ” (*mushj*): a mixture or joined thing. Plural is “أَمْشَاجٌ” (*amshaaj*) {T, R}.

The Quran says:

76:2	We created man from a matter which has a mixture of different potentialities	إِنَّا خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ نُطْفَةٍ أَمْشَاجٍ
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This creates genes in the ovum of the mother

76:2	We so manage it that the latent abilities develop and it is transformed into a human being with hearing and seeing abilities	نَبِّئْنَاهُ فَجَعَلْنَاهُ سَمِيعًا بَصِيرًا
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“مَشَى” (*mashy*): to walk:

Raghib says that “مَشَى” (*mashy*) means to transfer from one place to another intentionally. Figuratively “مَشَى” (*mashy*) means to get guidance and to seek guidance {*T, M*}.

“الْمَاشِيَةُ” (*al-mashiya*) with plural “الْمَوَاشِي” (*al-mawashi*) means four legged animals like camels, goats, etc.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “مَشَاءٌ” (*masha-un*) means abundance and to develop.

“إِمْرَأَةٌ مَّا شِيَتْ” (*imra'atun maashiyah*): a woman with many children {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are “movement of a man” and “develop and abundance”.

The Quran has used “قَامُوا” (*qaamu*) against “مَشَوْا” (*mashyun*) in (2:20) i.e. “to walk”.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:159	Do they have legs to walk on?	أَلَهُمْ أَرْجُلٌ يَمْشُونَ بِهَا
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Surah *Al-Qalam* says:

68:11	a man who takes the news from one place to another a lot (who backbites a lot)	مَشَّاءٌ بِنَمِيمٍ
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“الْمِصْرُ” (*al-misr*): the border or partition between two things.

“مِصْرٌ” (*misrun*): a town, because it is limited.

“مَمْصُورٌ” (*mumsoor*): it has borders around it.

“مِصْرٌ” (*misr*): some town or area.

“مِصْرٌ” (*misr*): a country (Egypt). It also means “red earth” {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran uses “مِصْرٌ” (*misr*) in (2:61) to mean “a city” or a limited dwelling place as against the unlimited open spaces.

Its root is (*S-Th-R*). See heading (*S-N-T-R*).

“الْمَضْغَةُ” (*al-musgha*): a piece of flesh. It can also mean a piece of other things too.

“مُضْغَةٌ مِنَ اللَّحْمِ” (*muzgha minal lahm*): amount of meat which can be put in mouth to chew, i.e. “a mouthful”.

“الْمَضَاغُ” (*al-mazaghu*): thing which is chewed.

“مَضْغَةٌ” (*mazgha*), “يَمْضَغُهُ” (*yamzagha*), “مَضَغًا” (*mazgha*): to chew something with teeth {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this word is to chew.

The Quran has described one of the different stages of the genes in the ovum as “مُضْغَةً” (*muzgha*) (22:5) i.e. the state in which the gene is like a lump of chewable flesh and the bones in it are still not hard.

“مَضَى الشَّيْءُ” (*mazash shaiyi*), “يَمْضِي” (*yamzi*): for something to pass away before or happen before.
 “مَضَى السَّيْفُ مَضَاءً” (*mazas saifu maza'aa*): the sword cut (as it was sharp). The sword (which is sharp) cuts whatever it strikes {T}.
 “الْمَاضِي” (*al-maazi*): lion, because due to its courage it stays in front and does carry out its intentions.

The Quran says:

8:38	The practices of former nations (historical events)	فَقَدْ مَضَتْ سُنَّتُ الْأَوَّلِينَ
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“الْمَطَرُ” (*al-matar*): the rain as in (4:102) {T}.
 “الْإِمْتَارُ” (*al-imtaar*): the rain of punishment {T}.

Raghib says it means a rain whose effects are good, and “أَمْطَرَ” (*amtar*) is rain whose effects are detrimental (bad) {R}.

Ibn Faris says “أُمْطِرَ” (*umtir*) appears only for punishment.

The Quran says about the “” (*azaab*) that the nation of *Luut* faced:

7:84	And We made it rain on them	وَأَمْطَرْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ مَطَرًا
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“مُمْطِرٌ” (*mumtir*): one who brings rain.
 “بَدَأَ عَارِضٌ مُّمْطِرُنَا” (*haaza aarizun mumtirna*): this cloud is about to rain on us (46:24).

“مَطَاً” (*mata*), “مَطْوًا” (*matwa*): he exerted in walking and walked fast.
 “مُطَوِّئًا” (*mutawa'u*): to stretch and yawn. Mostly it means a stretching that comes at the time of fever.
 “مَطَاوً” (*matawa*) and “تَمَطَّى” (*tamatta*): to increase, to become long, to extend. *Ibn Faris* says these are its basic meanings.
 “تَمَطَّى النَّهَارُ” (*tamattan anhar*): the day stretched, that is, after the sunrise it progressed.
 “الْتَمَطَّى” (*at-tamatti*): to walk proudly, to extend hands and to spread them while walking {T, R}.

Raghib says “الْمَطَا” (*al-mata*) means back and “تَمَطَّى” (*tamatta*) means to raise and extend one's back. This is the condition when one walks rakishly.

The Quran says:

75:34	He went to his companions triumphantly (in a preening way)	ذَهَبَ إِلَى أَهْلِهِ يَتَمَطَّى
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“مَعَ” (*ma'a*): “with”, “along with”, both physically and figuratively

To mean “being with physically” the Quran says:

12:36	two young men entered the prison along with him	دَخَلَ مَعَهُ السَّجَنَ قَتِيلَيْنِ
8:66	Allah is with those who are persevering	وَاللَّهُ مَعَ الصَّابِرِينَ

It means, Allah’s help is with those who are persevering.

It sometimes appears to mean “عِنْدَ” (*inda*) or “near”.

“جِئْتُ مِنْ مَعَ الْقَوْمِ” (*je'tu min ma'a-il qaum*): I came near (close to) the nation.

M-Ain-Z

م ع ز

“مَعَزٌ” (*ma'az*) with its plural form “مَاعِزٌ” (*maa-iz*) has appeared in 6:144.

“الْمَاعِزُ” (*al-maa'iz*): a man with a strong body

“الْمَعِزُ” (*al-m'aaz*): a goat, because in comparison to “ضَائِلٌ” (*zaan*) (sheep) it has a kind of hardness.

Ibn Faris says it basically means solidity and intensity in something.

M-Ain-N

م ع ن

“الْمَعْنُ” (*al-ma'an*): insignificant and lowly thing.

While it means “short” and “a little” on one hand, on the other it is also used to mean “long” and “abundant” as the water that flows on the surface of the ground.

“الْمَاعُونُ” (*al-maa'oan*): any good deed, as rain because it is received from God without any effort.

Anything that is benefited from; anything which cannot be stopped by those who ask for it; things of nurturing or development.

“مَعَنَ الْفَرَسُ” (*maa'nal fars*): the horse went past while running.

“مَعَنَ الْمَاءُ” (*maa'nal maa'u*): the water flowed.

“مَعَنَ النَّبْتُ” (*maa'anan nabt*): the plants had enough of water.

“مَعِينٌ” (*maeen*): open water that is flowing {*T, M, Lataif-ul-Lugha*}.

Ibn Faris says that it means ease in flow or walk, or something which is done easily.

The Quran says:

23:50	Land which is smooth (even) and in which water flows	ذَاتَ قَرَارٍ وَ مَعِينٍ
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Surah *Al-Ma'on* says:

107:7	They hold back things which Allah has given for the benefit of all	وَيَمْنَعُونَ الْمَاعُونَ
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This means things of nourishment must be kept like flowing water, available to all, whoever needs those things must be able to take them and fulfil his needs.

Some say that “مَعِينٌ” (*maeen*) has been derived from “عَيْنٌ” (*ain*) {*T*}. As such, it has also been mentioned under the heading (*Ain-Y-N*).

“الْمُعَى” (*al-maa'u*), “الْمُعَى” (*al-me'aa*): intestine. Plural is “أَمْعَاءُ” (*am-aa'u*) which means “a thing cut to pieces”. “تَمَعَّى الشَّرُّ فِيمَا بَيْنَهُمْ” (*tamayyush sharru feema bainahum sharr*): spread among them {*T, M*}.

The Quran in verse (47:15) says that hot water in *jahannam* will be annihilating instead of life-giving “فَقَطَّعَ أَمْعَاءَهُمْ” (*faqatta'a am'aahum*) and will cut their (the people's) intestines to pieces, their life will be terminated, or the sources of life will cease, or will be deprived of things of sustenance. (Note that intestines area major source in turning the food into assimilative product to become a part of the body).

“الْمَقْتُ” (*al-maqt*): severe enmity against a man who has become habitual of bad things {*R*}. “نِكَاحُ الْمَقْتِ” (*nikaahul maqt*): to wed the widow of one's father. In the pre-Quranic era this was a common practice {*T*}. The Quran has prohibited this strongly in (4:22). This word is used to mean hatred too.

40:10	Allah's frustration is greater than your frustration	لَمَقْتُ اللَّهَ أَكْبَرَ مِنْ مَقْتِكُمْ أَنْفُسَكُمْ
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“مَقْتُ اللَّهِ” (*maqaatil laah*): bad deeds of man whose results are compiled according to Allah's laws.

61:3	It is highly displeasing to <i>Allah</i> that you say what you do not practice	كَبُرَ مَقْتًا عِنْدَ اللَّهِ أَنْ تَقُولُوا مَا لَا تَفْعَلُونَ
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For further details see heading (*Gh-Zd-B*) and (*S-Kh-Th*).

“الْمَكْتُ” (*al-maks*): to wait stolidly at some place.
 “الْمَاكِي” (*al-maakis*): one who lies in wait at some place.
 “الْمَتَمَكِّي” (*al-matamakki*): one who waits.
 “الْمَاكَا” (*al-makaas*): to delay, to wait.
 “الْتَمَكُّ” (*at-tamakkus*): to wait for somebody {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran states that you want longevity or permanence, you want your memories to last, you want life forever, you want your deeds to always be remembered. For that the basic principle is:

13:17	The thing that is beneficial to mankind will remain on earth	مَا يَنْفَعُ النَّاسَ فَيَمْكُثْ فِي الْأَرْضِ
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In the world, “The Survival of the Fittest” is the principle which rules, but here it is the “Principle of the Most Beneficial that survives”. So if you want your name to be remembered then do something beneficial for humanity. Whatever you do in this vein must not be limited to any particular group, individual or nation but it should be beneficial equally for all mankind. This is what the Quran and Islam wants because Allah is Sustainer (*Rabb*) of the Universe.

Surah *Bani Israel* says:

17:106	We have revealed the Quran gradually and have related its subjects separately, so that you can present it to the people in the same gradual way	وَقُرْآنًا فَرَقْنَاهُ لِتَقْرَأَهُ عَلَى النَّاسِ عَلَى مُكْثٍ وَنَزَّلْنَاهُ تَنْزِيلًا
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Surah *An-Namal* and Surah *Al-Qasas* say:

27:22	he stayed a short while	فَمَكَثَ غَيْرَ بَعِيدٍ
28:29	(<i>Moosa</i> told his family) wait here.	أَمْكُثُوا

“الْمَكْرُ” (*al-makr*): secret plan, scheme.

“التَّكْيُرُ” (*at-tamkeer*): when grain, etc, is secretly hoarded at home.

“الْمَكْرُ” (*al-makr*): war planning or scheming {T}.

Al-manaar says that “مَكْرٌ” (*makr*) is such a secret plan in which targeted person is taken to a stage which he cannot even conceive or imagine {T, *Al-manaar*}.

The Quran terms the schemes of the opponents as “مَكْرٌ” (*makr*), and the reply from the group of *momineen* or the results of their own wrong deeds according to Allah’s laws is “مَكْرٌ” (*makr*) as well {T, R}.

8:30	They were scheming against you and Allah’s law was scheming against them. Allah’s schemes are best, very powerful and effective	وَيَمْكُرُونَ وَيَمْكُرُ اللَّهُ - وَاللَّهُ خَيْرُ الْمَاكِرِينَ
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“مَكَّ الْعَظْمُ” (*makk al-azm*): he sucked the bone and removed all its marrow {T, R}. *Ibn Faris* says this is its basic meaning

“مَكَّ الْفَصِيلُ مَا فِي ضَرْعِ أُمِّ” (*makkal faseelu maa fee zar-i ummihi*): the camel kid sucked all the milk that was in its mother’s teats.

“مَكَّهُ” (*makkah*): he killed him, decreased him {T, R}.

Yaqoob says that “مَكَّةُ” (*mecca*) means the entire mosque.

There is a difference of opinion as to why the place is called *mecca*:

- 1) for example one opinion is that it is called *mecca* because it decreases or destroys sins
- 2) since water was scarce there, its inhabitants sort of used to suck all its water.
- 3) since this city attracts people towards it and absorbs them it is called “مَكَّةُ” (*mecca*).
- 4) just as “بَكٌّ” (*buck*) means a crowd so does “مَكٌّ” (*muck*) mean a crowd.
- 5) “مُكَأَكُّ” (*mukaak*) and “مُكَأَكَّهُ” (*mukaakah*) means bone marrow {T, R}, which is in the centre of the bone and since this city is in the middle of the world it is called *mecca*.

The Quran has used *mecca* to mean the city which holds the mosque of *Ka’ba* (48:46). The same city has also been called “بَكَّةُ” (*bakka*) in (3:95). See heading (B-K-K) too.

It means Mecca. See heading (M-K-K) and (B-K-K).

“الْمَكْنَةُ” (*al-makinah*): grandeur and power or authority

“الْمُكْنَةُ” (*al-muknah*): the ability.

“الْمَكَانَةُ” (*al-makaanah*): peace and respect.

“الْمَكَانُ” (*al-makaan*): a place which is overpowering and encompassing something {T}.

Ibn Faris says “الْمُكْنَاتُ” (*al-muknaat*) means the nests of birds.

Some think that the root of “مَكَانٌ” (*makaan*) is (*K-W-N*), and it also means the method or direction.

The Quran says:

14:17	death will come towards it from all sides	وَيَأْتِيهِ الْمَوْتُ مِنْ كُلِّ مَكَانٍ
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This is from the root (**K-W-N**).

The Quran says:

4:20	a wife in place of another wife	زَوْجَ مَكَانَ زَوْجٍ
10:28	to stay in its place	مَكَانَكُمْ
19:57	and We granted him a lofty place	وَرَفَعْنَاهُ مَكَانًا عَلِيًّا
6:167	do what you can as per your power	إِعْمَلُوا عَلَىٰ مَكَاتِبِكُمْ
36:27	despite their strength we annihilate them (reduce their power to weakness)	لَمَسْخَنَّهُمْ عَلَىٰ مَكَاتِبِهِمْ
24:55	He will make their Deen strong and established for them, will make their way of life the way of the world (grant power)	وَلَيُمَكِّنَنَّ لَهُمْ دِينَهُمْ
12:56	Thus we granted Yusuf the authority in the land	كَذَٰلِكَ مَكَّنَّا لِيُوسُفَ فِي الْأَرْضِ

“مَكَّنَ الشَّيْءُ” (*makunash shaiyi*): the thing was strengthened and became strong, became solid, became stolid in its place.

“أَمَكَّنَ فُلَانًا الْأَمْرَ” (*amkana fulanal amr*): the work became easy for that man, he overpowered him.

“تَمَكَّنَ مِنَ الْأَمْرِ” (*tamakkana minal amr*): he overpowered him and became successful {T}.

“مَكَانَ” (*makaan*): respect and value.

“مَكِينٌ” (*makeen*): one with great ability and rank, one who sits stolidly in his place.

“عِنْدَ ذِي الْعَرْشِ مَكِينٌ” (*inda zil arshi makeen*): respectable before the possessor of the heavens (81:21).

“مَكَّنَ” (*makkan*): to fix, to make strong, to make stable.

“أَمَكَّنَهُ مِنَ الشَّيْءِ” (*amkana minash shaiyi*): made him authoritative, gave him power over something.

Surah *Al-Infaal* says:

8:71	so Allah overpowered them	فَأَمَكَّنَ مِنْهُمْ
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The Quran has related three methods of verifying the truth of its claims. One is to deliberate upon the truths or knowledge of the times, or historic truths as to how the nations which adopted the wrong path had been destroyed. The third is the pragmatic test which means “let the system establish itself through human efforts and produce its results” (10:39). The results will speak for themselves.

The Quran believes firmly on its claims that it exhorts taking this pragmatic test as its proof. Therefore, the Messenger **Muhammed** tells his opponents repeatedly to continue working as per your strengths.

6:136	soon the results will decide as to who is successful	فَسَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ مَنْ تَكُونُ لَهُ عَاقِبَةُ
6:136	You will see that the nation that slackens in giving humanity its due rights and rebels against Allah’s laws, can never succeed	إِنَّهُ لَا يَفْلِحُ الظَّالِمُونَ

This was the way, through which Islam’s truth was established, i.e. to tell the world through its practical results that this system is without parallel. This was the Islamic claim. Nowadays the situation is such that even if some people want to turn to Islam by being impressed by its universal appeal, they are turned away by seeing the practical despondence of the **muslims**, and think that a religion whose followers face the ignominy that is done by the **muslims** presently, can never be the harbinger of emancipation to humankind at large. Even so, if the **muslims** are told that they are not following the **Deen** which Allah had ordained (but something similar to it) then they get so angry that they are ready to fight you. This is because they have refused to test deeds through their results as per the Quran. Now they have no criterion whereby they can judge whatever that is being done by them is right or wrong.

There is only one criterion and that is whether the result of the deeds that the Quran has told us are being produced accordingly or not. If our deeds are producing the said results then the deeds are being done

correctly. If they are not producing the said results, then the deeds are not being performed correctly. It is correct that result of all the deeds will not be manifested before death but there are some results which will definitely be manifested. According to the Quran some results will be manifested in this life too, and they can determine if the deeds we are doing are being done rightly. The ignominy and deprivation in this world means the punishment by Allah, and if we are doing the deeds according to the Quran, these deprivations cannot remain with us.

M-K-W

م ك و

“مَكَا” (*maka*), “يَمْكُو” (*yamku*), “مُكَا” (*muka’a*): to whistle {T}.

Ibn Faris says this means by putting the fingers in a particular way in the mouth and whistle.

Raghib says “مَكَا الطَّيْرُ” (*mukat tair*) means “to whistle like a bird” {R}.

“الْمُكَّا” (*al-mukka’u*) is a small bird which stays in gardens. It got its name because its voice is like a whistle.

The Quran says about the Arabs of the dark period (i.e. before the advent of the Quran):

8:35	Near the House of <i>Ka’ba</i> , their <i>salaat</i> is nothing but some meaningless sounds and meaningless movements	مَا كَانَ صَلَاتُهُمْ عِنْدَ الْبَيْتِ إِلَّا نَكَاءٌ وَتَصْدِيدٌ
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This means their prayers in which some words are recited and some acts performed (i.e. soulless praying). Just think and observe that today’s prayers where we simply recite some words whose meanings we do not know, and do some movements about which we do not know why these are performed? Although the Quran had directed to establish *salaat* which is a means of bringing change of minds and thinking and the source of bringing a revolution in a society, the society where every man would be aware as to what he was doing and why? And what will be its result? Every aspect of *Deen* has a purpose and helps attain the high ideal of humanity. But when the real purpose of *Deen* becomes obscured then these life giving links of that program (*Deen*) are reduced simply to being a custom, part of a meaningless worship, and the rituals are then performed thinking as if these are the very aim. At this juncture *Deen* (Way of life) is reduced simply to a religion.

M-L-A

م ل ا

“مَلَأَ الشَّيْءَ يَمْلَأُهُ مَلَأٌ” (*mala ash shaiyi yamluhu maala*): filled something.

“فَامْتَلَأَ” (*famtala’a*): so it was filled.

“لَا مَلَأَنَّ جَهَنَّمَ” (*la mala unna jahannam*): I will surely fill the *jahannam* (7:18).

“مِلَى” (*mil un*): the quantity with which something is filled {T}.

“مِلْءُ الْأَرْضِ ذَبَابًا” (*mil ul ardi zahaba*): plenty of gold (3:90)

“مَالِئُونَ” (*maalioon*): those who fill (37:66).

“الْمَلَأُ” (*al-mala’o*): to consult among themselves, group. The leaders and elite of a nation, the elite {T}

“الْمَلَأُ الْأَعْلَى” (*al-mala ul-aala*): cannot bear or listen to what the elite say (37:8). Here the meaning is that which transpires in the world of God.

“الْمَلَأُ” (*almilaa-o*) and “الْأَعْلَى” (*al-mala’o*): rich people, or those people who have everything they need in abundance, or all of those whose needs are fulfilled {T}.

The Quran has used “الْمَلَأُ” (*al-mala’o*) in these meanings too:

23:33	who had abundance of life’s accoutrements	أَتَرْتَهُمْ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا
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The Quran says that the rich people of the entire nation, whom the messengers were sent to oppose them:

34:34	It has never occurred that We have sent a warner to a	وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا فِي قَرْيَةٍ مِنْ نَذِيرٍ إِلَّا قَالَ مُتْرَفُوهَا إِنَّا بِمَا
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	town, and the wealthy ones did not say “we disbelieve in the revelation ”	أُرْسِلْتُمْ بِهِ كَافِرُونَ
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It is obvious then that the Messengers came with a message that hurt the rich people the most. That is why they opposed the message so vehemently. If the matter was confined only to worship then they would not have opposed the message in such a manner because then it would not be hurtful to them at all. They on the other hand support these programs and give to charities. The Quranic verses are witness to the fact that the program which the messengers brought all entailed the program of snatching the holds on things of sustenance or the resources from the rich and privileged and put them under the law of sustenance as ordained by Allah. This was the reason that particular group of people oppose the revelation because its success meant the elimination of human exploitation and equitable distribution of wealth in a society.

This has been the case since long and will continue to be so. Today too, wherever the revolutionary message brought by the Quran is mentioned, it will be opposed tooth and nail by this group of people, and religious monasticism will be hand in glove with it.

See heading (*Te-R-F*).

M-L-H

م ل ح

“الْمِلْحُ” (*al-milḥ*): salt, very salty (brackish) water.

“الْمَلَّاحُ” (*al-mallah’u*): one who sells salt. It also means “sailor” as he is always at sea (or in brackish water).

The Arabs used to hold salt in great esteem and therefore “الْمِلْحُ” (*al-milḥ*) was also used to mean responsibility and courtesy, and for fine and aesthetic sense too.

Ibn Faris says it means to be white, and salt is so called because it is white.

The Quran has used “مِلْحٌ” (*milḥ*) to mean very brackish water.
“بَذَا مِلْحٍ أَجَاجٌ” (*haaza milhun ujaaj*): it is very brackish (25:35).

M-L-Q

م ل ق

“مَلَقٌ” (*malaq*), “يَمْلِقُ” (*yamliq*): obliterated, softened.

“الْمَالِقُ” (*al-maalq*): the wooden board with which land is cultivated, or which is used as plough to smooth or made even.

“مَلَقَ الْأَرْضَ تَمْلِيقًا” (*mallaqal arda tamleeqa*): to even out the land with the wooden board.

“تَمْلِقُ” (*tamalluqu*) and “مَلَقٌ” (*malaq*): to soften or smooth someone.

“إِنْمَلَقُ” (*inmalaq*): to be smooth.

“الْمَلَقَةُ” (*al-malagah*): smooth stone {*T, M*}.

“الْمَلِيقُ” (*al-maliq*): weak and feeble whom the vicissitudes of time have made so.

“الْمُمْلِقُ” (*al-mumliq*): a man who has nothing, is a pauper.

“أَمْلَقَ مَامَعَهُ” (*amlaqa mamahu*): whatever he had, he spent it, and kept nothing back.

“رَجُلٌ أَمْلَقَ مِنَ الْمَالِ” (*rajulun amlaqu minal maal*): a man who has no wealth left {*T, M*}.

“إِمْلَاقٌ” (*imlaaq*): poverty.

Ibn Faris says it means to be deprived of something and something to be softened.

The Quran says:

6:152	due to the fear that you will become a pauper, do not kill your children	لَا تَقْتُلُوا أَوْلَادَكُمْ مِنْ إِمْلَاقٍ
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6:152	Do not kill or do not deprive them of education	نَحْنُ نَرْزُقُكُمْ وَاِيَّاهُمْ
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In a Quranic system, it will be the responsibility of the system to arrange for your sustenance and your children too. Responsibilities that Allah has said as his own are fulfilled by this system which is established to implement His laws.

M-L-K م ل ك

“مَلِكٌ” (*mulk*): to have the capacity, to have the power, to dominate and be overpowering {*M*}. It also means authority and intent, firm basis, the support on which something is established.

That is why water and food and other such things are called “مِلْكٌ” (*milk*) because they support the life on earth.

The Arabs say “لِي فِي الْوَادِي مَلِكٌ” (*li fil waadi milk*) which means “this valley has grazing land, water and cattle and every other thing”. In the desert, water is the greatest life sustaining thing, so it is called “مِلْكٌ” (*milk*).

“لَيْسَ لَهُمْ مَلِكٌ” (*laisa lahum milk*): they do not have water.

The Arabs have a proverb which says “الْمَاءُ مَلَكٌ أَمْرُهُ” (*al-maa'u malak amruhu*) which means “water rectifies everything, or takes care of every matter” i.e. one who has water is independent and everything is sorted out for him {*L*}.

Anything with which any matter is set right and reaches its peak is called “مِلَاكُ الْأَمْرِ” (*milaakul amr*). “مِلَاكٌ” (*milaakun*) also means plaster {*T, F*}, because with it stones, etc. are set right.

“مَلَكُ الْعَجِينِ يَمْلِكُهُ” (*malakal ajeena yamlikhu*): to knead the flour well, so that all its elements become homogenous or mixed well {*T, F*}.

Nawab Siddiq Hassan Khan says that the characteristic of this root (*M-L-K*) is strength and intensity {*Al-ilm-ul-Khafaq*}.

“مَلِكُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*malikut tareeq*), “مِلْكُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*milkut tareeq*), “مُلْكُ الطَّرِيقِ” (*mulkut tareeq*): the limit of a path, and also the middle or big part of a path {*T, F*}.

“مَلَكُوتٌ” (*malakuut*): respect and authority, government and statehood. This word is also used to mean “a great country”, but the word is particular to mean “Allah’s authority”, because complete authority in the universe belongs to Allah. He alone supports the universe and is the basis for it and all operations therein are due to Him.

“مَالِكٌ” (*maalik*): a man of authority and right.

In Surah *An-Nahal* verse (16:73) “لَا يَمْلِكُ” (*la yamliku*) i.e. not have power has been further elaborated by the term “لَا يَسْتَطِيعُونَ” (*la yastati-oon*) i.e. cannot possibly have power.

Similarly “مَمْلُوكٌ” (*mumlook*) has been explained by “لَا يَقْدِرُ عَلَى شَيْءٍ” (*la yaqaadiru ala shaiyin*) in (16:75) i.e. on which there is no authority or right.

Surah *Yasin* has clarified that “مَالِكٌ” (*maalik*) is one who is obeyed by another.

Surah *Al-Bagra* (in respect of *Taalot*) has said:

2:246	appoint some commander for us (so that we fight under his command)	وَابْعَثْ لَنَا مَلِكًا
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A commander is one who has authority. In the verse adjacent to it, the meaning of “مَلِكٌ” (*mulk*) is also authority.

20:87	the promise we made to you, was not broken intentionally {T}.	مَا أَخْلَفْنَا مَوْعِدَكَ بِمَلِكِنَا
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The above explanations make it obvious that while by “مَالِكٌ” (*maalik*) it is meant that Allah has complete right and authority, it is also conceived that it is thus so that the system of the universe proceeds rightly and according to His laws not for some oppressive purpose, and so that everything continues to get what is essential for its existence.

The Quran uses a term “مِمَّا مَلَكَتْ أَيْمَانُكُمْ” (*maa malakat aimanukum*) which literally means “whom your right hands possess”. This phrase has been used to mean several things, for example to mean subordinates who work according to someone’s plan. Household servants etc. are also included in this category. See (30:28, 24:58, 24:31, 16:71, 4:36). It also means the women who have entered wedlock (33:52).

In Surah *Al-Nisa* verse (4:24) if “*muhsinaatu*” is taken to mean chaste women then:

4:24	Chaste women are prohibited for you except those who enter your wedlock	وَالْمُحْصَنَاتُ مِنَ النِّسَاءِ إِلَّا مَا مَلَكَتْ أَيْمَانُكُمْ
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If ‘*muhsinaat*’ means ‘women with husbands’ (see heading *H-Sd-N*) then this verse would mean:

4:24	All women with husbands are forbidden for you, except the slave girls or women who are already in your slavery (although they may have husbands somewhere)	إِلَّا مَا مَلَكَتْ أَيْمَانُكُمْ
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But in Surah *Al-Mumtihinah* it is said that if the women of the unbelievers come to you then do not make them return to the unbelievers but give them (the unbelievers) the money they have spent on the women and wed them (60:10). These are the ‘women with husbands’ with whom wedlock was allowed. In this vein verse (4:24) could also mean “these women who were married in this way”.

These words have also been used to mean slave girls in other verses like (33:50), (70:30), and (23:6). Before the advent of Islam the Arab society permitted keeping slaves and slave girls. When Islam arrived these slave girls were not turned out and allowed to stay where they were, because turning them out would have caused a lot of ills in the society due to economic reasons. The Quran has used these words to mean these slave girls too.

In Surah *Muhammed* clear directions were given that these prisoners were to be freed either as a favour or after receiving some compensation. Thus Islam ended the major source of slavery, to purchase a human being for keeping him or her as a slave is very much against the teachings of the Quran which advocates respect for human beings (17:70), leave alone allow one man to be master of another and order him around as a slave (3:78).

These explanations make clear that wherever the phrase “مَمْلُوكٌ” (*maa malakat*) has been used to mean slave girls, it has been used for slave girls as were there in Arab society before the advent of Islam. These slave girls were gradually absorbed as individuals of the free society and since the system of making new slaves had been prohibited by the Quran. Therefore the system of slavery or slave girls ended from among the *muslims*. As such, those who cite “مَمْلُوكٌ أَيْمَانُكُمْ” (*maa malakat aimaanukum*) as an instance for keeping slaves are mistaken and do injustice to the Quran. The benefit of this phrase in the Quran nowadays is that if a nation in which slavery is still prevalent enters or accepts Islam then this verse would provide guidance and direction to end it.

With reference to “مَمْلُوكٌ أَيْمَانُكُمْ” (*maa malakat aimaanukum*), also see heading (*Y-M-N*).

For the meaning of “مَلِكَةٌ” (*mala'ikah*), see heading (*A-L-K*).

“أَمَلْتُ الْكِتَابَ عَلَى الْكَاتِبِ” (*am laltul kitaaba alal kaatib*): the book I dictated to the writer {*M*}. To mean this, the root has appeared in (2:284).

Raghib says “مِلَّةٌ” (*milah*) has been derived from it. As such, “مِلَّةٌ” (*millah*) means “written law”.

“طَرِيقٌ مَلِيلٌ” (*tareequn maleel*): that clear path which is much used.

“مِلَّةٌ” (*millah*): method, way or path.

Abu Ishaq also supports this meaning and *Asaas* too supports it.

“مِلَّةٌ” (*millah*) has been derived from it because it means a place where bread is baked and at such a place footprints make their mark from much comings and goings.

“الْمَلَّةُ” (*al-mallah*): hot sand over which bread is sometimes cooked {*T*}.

Manavi says “مَلَالٌ” (*malaal*) means the tiredness and frustration that is created by doing something continuously {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it means to become tired of something and to be tired.

The Quran has used the word “مِلَّةٌ” (*millah*) to mean the path or the way, as in:

2:140	Until you follow their way (<i>deen</i>)	حَتَّى تَتَّبِعَ مِلَّتَهُمْ
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Islam has been called “مِلَّةَ إِبْرَاهِيمَ” (*millata ibrahim*) in (2:135), i.e. “the way which as per Allah’s directions *Ibrahim* had followed”.

M-L-W/Y م ل و ي

“إِمْلَاءٌ” (*imla’un*): to extend (to give more time or show laxity).

“مَلَاوَةٌ مِنَ الدَّهْرِ” (*malaawat minaddabri*), “مَلِيَّامِنُ الدَّهْرِ” (*maliyamin naddabri*): a very long period of time {*R*}.

“الْمَلِيَّيْنِ” (*al-maliyyun*): a long period of time. *Ibn Faris* says that this is its basic meaning

The Quran says:

19:46	get away from me for a long period	وَاهْجُرْنِي مَلِيًّا
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“أَمَلَيْتُ الْبَعِيرَ” (*amlaliat ul-ba’eer*): I created vastness in the camel’s pen (where it was fastened), so it loosened it {*T*}.

Surah *Muhammed* says about the *shaitaan* or rebellious forces:

47:25	He keeps making tall promises to them (gives them false hopes)	وَ أَمْلَى لَهُمْ
7:183	I give them time.	وَ أَمْلَى لَهُمْ

“أَمَلَيْتُ الْكِتَابَ” (*am lait-ul-kitaab*): I dictated the book.

“أَمَلْتُ” (*amlalt*): dictation {*R*}.

The Quran says:

2:282	Should get it written down	فَلْيُمْلَأْ
25:5	And they are dictated to him	فَهِيَ تُمْلَى عَلَيْهِ

See heading (*M-L-L*).

See heading “مِنْ” (*min*) and heading “مَا” (*maa*). Sometimes its last *alif* is not written and “مَمَّ” (*mimma*) remains.

Man مَنْ

“مَنْ” (*man*): “that”, “which” or “whichever”.

It is used in asking a question, i.e. “who”, “which”:

21:19	Whatever there is in the heavens and the earth belongs to Allah	وَلَهُ مَنْ فِي السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
36:52	who has awakened us from our sleeping place?	مَنْ بَعَثَنَا مِنْ مَرْقَدِنَا

Min مِنْ

“مِنْ” (*min*) is used to mean “from”:

17:1	from the <i>masjid-al-haraam</i> , i.e. that was the starting point of the journey	مِنْ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ
27:30	it is from <i>Suleman</i>	إِنَّهُ مِنْ سُلَيْمَانَ

“مِنْ” (*min*) is used to mean “some from amongst the whole lot”:

2:253	Allah has spoken with some among them	مِنْهُمْ مَنْ كَلَّمَ اللَّهَ
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“مِنْ” (*min*) is also used for the entire group:

35:2	whichever beneficence Allah grants mankind	مَا يَفْتَحِ اللَّهُ لِلنَّاسِ مِنْ رَحْمَةٍ
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It does not mean that He sends a part from the beneficence. What is defined as beneficence is entirely beneficence. It will not be a part of the beneficence.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:132	Whichever sign you bring to us (we will treat all signs like this)	مَهُمَا تَأْتِيَنَا بِهِ مِنْ آيَةٍ
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“مِنْ” (*min*) is also used for to mean “because of” or “due to”:

71:25	they were drowned because of their sins or wrong doings	بِمَا خَطِئْتِهِمْ أُغْرِقُوا
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“مِنْ” (*min*) is also used for to distinguish between one another:

2:220	Allah well knows who is a wrong doer or on the right path (He can easily distinguish one from the other)	وَاللَّهُ يَعْلَمُ الْمُفْسِدَ مِنَ الْمُصْلِحِ
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“مِنْ” (*min*) is also used to mean “one in place of another”:

9:38	Have you become agreeable to the immediate benefit in place of or against the future?	أَرْضَيْتُمْ بِالْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا مِنَ الْآخِرَةِ
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Also see (43:60).

“مِنْ” (*min*) is also used to mean “exhortation” of the negative:

3:61	there is no other god except Allah	وَمَا مِنْ إِلَهٍ إِلَّا اللَّهُ
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“مِنْ” (*min*) is also used to mean “along with”:

42:45	they must be watching along with from the corner of their eyes	يَنْظُرُونَ مِنْ طَرْفٍ خَفِيٍّ
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Also see (97:4).

“مِنْ” (*min*) is also used to mean “on” or “over”:

21:77	And we made them dominant over that nation.	وَنَصَرْنَاهُ مِنَ الْقَوْمِ
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“**min**” (*min*) is also used to mean “in”:

62:9	When you are called to prayers in Friday	إِذَا تُؤَدَّى الصَّلَاةُ مِنْ يَوْمِ الْجُمُعَةِ
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“**min**” (*min*) is also used to mean “from” or “of”:

21:97	We were unaware of them (from their side)	قَدْ كُنَّا فِي غَفْلَةٍ مِنْ هَذَا
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“**min**” (*min*) is also used to mean “for him” or “over him”:

58:17	Against Allah, their wealth and progeny will do no good for them	لَنْ تُغْنِيَ عَنْهُمْ أَمْوَالُهُمْ وَلَا أَوْلَادُهُمْ مِنَ اللَّهِ شَيْئًا
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“**min**” (*min*) is also redundant sometimes:

6:59	No leaves fall without....	مَا تَسْقُطُ مِنْ وَرَقَةٍ
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It can also mean to put emphasis on something.

M-N-Ain م ن ع

Ibn Faris says “**man’a**” (*man’a*) is the opposite of “**i’ta’un**” (*i’ta’un*), i.e. “to not give”. *Raghib* too supports this claim.

“**mun’a**” (*mun’a*): to intervene between a person and the thing that which he wishes to obtain.

“**imtana’a**” (*imtana’a*), “**imtina’a**” (*imtina’a*): to abstain, to stop, forbid, one who prevents {T}.

“**man’u**” (*man’u*) and “**man’u’**” (*man’u’*) are more exaggerated than “**man’**” (*man’*), i.e. “one who stops very much”.

“**man’**” (*man’*), “**man’u**” (*man’u*), “**man’u’**” (*man’u’*): miser who stops and does not let go of anything {R}.

“**al-mun’a**” (*al-mun’a*): to stop, to be safe.

“**man’ ar rajul**” (*man’ ar rajul*): the man became safe.

“**hisnun manih**” (*hisnun manih*): safe and strong fort.

“**al-mumana’ah**” (*al-mumana’ah*): to struggle or quarrel to prevent one another {T}.

The Quran says:

2:114	Who can be more oppressive than one who prevents others from reciting Allah’s name (or word) in the mosques	وَمَنْ أَظْلَمُ مِمَّنْ مَنَعَ مَسْجِدَ اللَّهِ أَنْ يُذَكَّرَ فِيهَا اسْمُهُ
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Here *mun’un* means “to hinder” or “intervene”.

Surah *Al-Nisa* says:

4:141	Have We not protected you through the believers?	وَنَنْعُكُمْ مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ
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Surah *Al-Ma’on* says:

107:7	They hinder things which should be free like flowing water, and possess them personally	وَيَمْنَعُونَ الْمَاعُونَ
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Surah *Al-Ma’arij* says about man’s psychological make-up:

70:21	when a man gets wealth, then instead of keeping it open (or available for others, he keeps it for himself	إِذَا مَسَّهُ الْخَيْرُ مَنُوعًا
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The next verse says that this mentality can be cured through the system of *Salaat*. Verse (29:45) also says so. The same thing is reiterated in Surah *Al-Qaf* by using the words “**man’a lil-khair**” (*man’a lil-khairi*).

Against this we have a heavenly society will have life's edibles in abundance (50:25), and where nobody will stop it, from being available to everyone (20:118, 20:35) and will be available for the sustenance of all (17:20, 107:7)

- “مَنْ” (*munna*): to obtain any beneficence from God with no major effort.
 “مَنْ عَلَيْهِ” (*munna alaih*): did him a favour, i.e. granted him something without any labour.
 “إِذَا مَنَّ عَلَيْهِ” (*imtunna alaih*): grant something without any labour.
 “مَنْ” (*munna*): to assert or remind of a favour which is not thought to be a good act.
 “الْمُنُونُ” (*al-manoon*): one who asserts favours too much. It also means “era” and “death”.
 “رَيْبُ الْمُنُونِ” (*raibul manoon*): the vicissitudes of life.
 “الْمَنَّانُ” (*al-mannan*): one who grants too many rewards {*T, M, Aqrab-al-Muwarid*}.

The Quran says that the Revelation too is “مَنْ” (*munna*) because it has been granted by Allah without any effort on our part (14:11). This “مَنْ” (*munna*) is for the Messenger, and for the Messenger to come to the people with this revelation is “مَنْ” (*munna*) from Allah (3:163). For the nation of *Bani Israel* to be liberated from Pharaoh’s oppression was Allah’s “مَنْ” (*munna*) (28:5).

About the prisoners of war, Surah *Muhaamed* says that they should be allowed to go as “مَنْ” (*munna*) or “فِدَاءً” (*fidyan*) i.e. against some compensation (47:4).

In Surah *Saad*, this word has been used opposite to “أَمْسِكْ” (*imsaak*) which means obstruction (38:39). Thus it is obvious that prisoners of war will have to be released, whether in exchange of compensation or for free.

Surah *Al-Mudassar* says:

74:6	do not do a favour in expectation that you will get better returns	وَلَا تَمُنُّنَ تَسْتَلِيزَ
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This makes the meaning of “مَنْ” (*munna*) very clear.

Surah *Al-Momin* says that those who spend in the path of Allah do so because:

2:262	They neither expect any return nor be the cause of any mental torture by stressing their favour	لَا يَشْعُرُونَ مَا أَتَوْا بِهَا بِمَنْعَةٍ وَلَا شَكْرٍ
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“مَنْ” (*munna*) is actually quite weighty {*T, M, Aqrab-al-Muwarid*}, thus stressing the favour means to burden someone with a heavy weight.

- “مَنْ” (*munna*) also means “to make tired”, or “to exhaust”, or “to weaken” or “enfeeble”.
 “مَنْ النَّاقَةِ” (*munnan naaqah*): weakened the camel because of the stress of the journey and enfeebled it. Hence it became weak by walking too much.
 “مَنْ السَّيْرِ فُلَانًا” (*munnas sairu fulana*): made it weak by walking so much.
 “ذَهَبَ بِمُنَّتِي” (*zahaba bi munnatihi*): wasted its strength.
 “الْمَنِينِ” (*al-maneen*): weak rope or weak man.
 “تَوْبَ مَنِينٍ” (*saubun maneen*): weak and feeble cloth.
 “الْمِنَّةُ” (*al-minanah*): spider.
 “مَنْ الشَّيْءِ” (*munnash shaiyi*): the thing decreased.
 “مُنُونٌ” (*manoon*): death or era.
 “مَنْ الْحَبْلِ” (*munnal habl*): cut the rope.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings are

- 1) to cut
- 2) to do a favour.

The Quran says:

95:6	Such returns await them which will not be decreased at all (they will get full return and not an iota less)	فَلَهُمْ أَجْرٌ غَيْرُ مَمْنُونٍ
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Also see (84:25) and (41:8).

Hence it means “uncut” or “continuous”. In evolution something can proceed ahead but cannot revert, either it will stop or proceed ahead. It can also mean that this return will be received by them not as a favour but as a matter of right.

52:30	The vicissitudes of time	رَبُّ الْمُنُونِ
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This word is also used for opposite meanings too.

“الْمُنَّةُ” (*al-muunnah*): strength, especially the strength of the heart. Therefore “مَمْنُونٌ” (*mumnoon*) means both strength and weakness {*T, M, Aqrab-al-Muwarid*}.

Ar Rumaani says “الْمُنُونُ” (*al-manoon*) means “death” {*Al-Fazal, Mutaradifa*}.

Lataif-ul-Lugha says it means “الدَّهْرُ” (*ad-dhahar*) or “the times”.

Raghib says that “مُنٌّ” (*mun*) and “سَلْوَى” (*salwa*) points to the beneficence of Allah.

The Quran says that the *Bani Israel* used to receive “مُنٌّ” (*mun*) in (2:57). This was a kind of sweet gum which used to accumulate on trees {*T, R*}. Even now it can be found and is very tasty.

“مُنٌّ” (*mun*) means the favours and “سَلْوَى” (*salwa*) means “the means of contentment” {*T, R*}.

Mana at مَذَوَّةُ

“مَذَوَّةُ” (*mana at*): an idol of the Arab tribes of *Khaza'a* and *Hazeel* {*T, M*} (53:20). *Laat* was the idol of the tribe *Saqeef* and *Uzza* the idol of the tribe *Ghutfaan*. All these three have been mentioned in (53:19) and (53:20).

M-N-Y م ن ي

“مَنَاهُ” (*manahu*), “يَمْنَاهُ” (*yamnaihi*), “مَنْيَا” (*manya*): estimated it.

“الْمَانِي” (*al-maani*): someone who estimates.

“الْمَنْيُ” (*al-man'yu*): Allah's estimate.

“الْمَنْيَةُ” (*al-maniyah*): death, because its time is estimated {*T, R*}.

“الْمُنَى” (*al-muna*) with its singular “الْمُنْيَةُ” (*al-munyah*) means “purpose”, “wishes” or “” (intent), i.e. “works which are estimated before-hand”.

“تَمَنَاهُ” (*tamannaahu*), “تَمَنَّى” (*tamanniya*): intended it, wished it.

“الْمُنْيَةُ” (*umniyyah*) with its plural form “الْمَانِي” (*amaaniyu*) means “wish” or “intent” {*T, R*}. It also means falsehood and lies.

“تَمَنَّى الْحَدِيثُ” (*tamannal hadees*): fabricated a false hood.

“الْأَمَانِيُّ” (*al-amaaniyyu*): things which are wished for and lies {*T, R*}.

“الْمَنْيُ” (*al-maniyyu*): sperm, as per its meaning of wish or intent, or because a human birth is estimated from it {*Ibn Faris*}.

“تَمَنَّى الْكِتَابَ” (*tamann al-kitaab*): read the book.

“الْمُنْيَةُ” (*umniyyah*): the reading of the book, whatever is read {*Ibn-Qateebah, F*}.

Taj-ul-Uroos has cited verses to prove this meaning.

Ibn Faris says by reading one can estimate the purpose of the book.

The Quran says:

2:78	uneducated are included among them who can only recite the book (but cannot understand its meanings)	
22:52	And any messenger before you that We sent to, then (after him) it so transpired that the book he recited from was interfered with. Thus another messenger was sent by Allah who would remove the	

	exaggerations from the Revelation and restore it to its former state.	
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In this verse God relates how people used to change the Revelation after a messenger and thus another messenger was sent to restore the original message. This continued till the advent of the Quran which was guaranteed safe keeping (from amendments and changes) by God Himself. Now nobody can make any changes in it. This is the true meaning of this verse, but many elaborators have translated “” (*umniyyatihi*) as “wish”, and thus created a difficulty for themselves. Then in order to get out of the difficulty and contradiction, they concocted a story to support their transgression.

M-W-T

م و ت

“مَوْتُ” (*maut*): is actually the opposite of life. Figuratively it also means “rest” {*T, M, R*}. Anything in which movement stops due to stagnancy is considered dead. Therefore “مَا تَتِ الرِّيحُ” (*maatatar reeh*) means “the wind stopped and became immobile” {*T, M, R*}.
 “مَا تَتِ النَّارُ” (*maatatin naar*): the fire was extinguished.
 “مَا تَتِ الْخَمْرُ” (*maatatil khamr*): “sleep” or “the stupor of the drink began to be dispelled”.
 “مَاتَ الرَّجُلُ” (*maatar rajul*): he went to sleep {*T, M, R*}.

There are different kinds of death:

1) for the strength of growth to be lost, as in:

30:19	Allah enlivens the land after its death	وَيُحْيِي الْأَرْضَ بَعْدَ مَوْتِهَا
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2) for the feeling to be lost:

19:23	<i>Maryam</i> said “If only I had died before this and was forgotten and wish I was unable to feel this ignominy and pain”	قَالَتْ يَلَيْتَنِي مِتُّ قَبْلَ هَذَا وَكُنْتُ نَسِيًّا مَنْسِيًّا
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3) the deterioration of intellect and consciousness:

27:80	You cannot make the dead listen (those who do not employ their intellect)	فَأَنذَرْتُكَ لَا تَسْمَعُ الْمَوْتَى
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4) fear and apprehension which can cause life to be blemished, i.e. difficult situations like poverty, ignominy, a life of subjugation etc.:

14:17	Difficulties from all sides will be approaching but death will not arrive. Only so much will be furnished as charity that will be enough to sustain life barely	وَيَأْتِيهِ الْمَوْتُ مِنْ كُلِّ مَكَانٍ وَمَا هُوَ بِمَيِّتٍ
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“مَوْتُ” (*maut*): “stupor” and “craziness”.

“الْمَيْتَةُ” (*al-maitah*): the animals which die without being slaughtered.

“الْمَوْتَةُ” (*al-mautah*): a condition akin to madness which seizes some people {*Ibn Faris*}.

The Quran has used “مَوْتُ” (*maut*) against “حَيَاة” (*hayat*) which means “life” (2:28). Just as life is not merely breathing but it has many aspects, death is not just to stop breathing but it has many aspects as well. The worst sort of that is collective death in which they are neither dead fully nor alive. This sort of life is hellish.

87:13	The message of the Quran is life giving only for those who have the ability to live on	لَهُمْ لَا يَمُوتُ فِيهَا وَلَا يَحْيَى
36:70	To warn he who is alive	لِيُنذِرَ مَنْ كَانَ حَيًّا

Wherever these words have appeared in the Quran, it will have to be determined with reference to the context these contain at that place. At every place “مَوْتُ” (*maut*) will not mean physical or clinical death. Also see heading (*H-Y-Y*).

“الْمَوْجُ” (*al-mauj*): wave.
 “مَاجِ الْمَوْجِ” (*maaj al-mauj*): the wave rose
 “الْمَوْجِ” (*al-mauj*): the tribulation of the sea waves.
 “مَاجِ يَمُوجِ” (*maaja yamuj*): surprise and wonder {*T, M, R*}.
 “مَوْجَةُ الشَّبَابِ” (*maujash shabaab*): the swing of youth, the height of youth.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is “tribulation”.

The Quran uses the word “مَوْجُ” (*mauj*) to mean “sea waves” in (10:22).

“مَارَ الشَّيْءُ يَمُورُ” (*maarash shaiyu yamoora*): for something to come again and again.
 “الْمَوْرُ” (*al-maur*): to turn around as “wave” and “tribulation”. It also means to flow with speed on the ground and be quickly mobile.
 “مَارَ مَوْرًا” (*maara maura*): he started coming and going.
 “الْمَوْرُ” (*al-maur*): much traversed, smooth path, fast pace, quickness and soft treading.
 “الْمُورُ” (*al-moor*): dust blown by the wind {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

52:9	With revolution, those on high ranks will be removed from their place and become very troubled	يَوْمَ تَمُورُ السَّمَاءُ مَوْرًا
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This meaning is derived from the figurative meaning of “سَمَاءُ” (*sama'a*).

“الْمُوسَى” (*al-moosa*): razor.
 “مَاسَ رَأْسَهُ” (*maasa raasahu*): he shaved off his head with a razor {*T, R*}.

“مُوسَى” (*Moosa/Moses*) is a Hebrew word which has been *Arabised* and it means “that which has been pulled out” {*T*}.

Since the Pharaoh's people had pulled *Moosa* out of the river when he was a child, he was named so {*M*}.

Ibrahim's grandson *Yaqoob* had the title of *Israel*. His descendants are called the *Bani Israel*. One of his sons was named *Yahuda*. The *Yahuda* and *Binyamin* tribes were settled in Palestinian area *Judea*. These two tribes were therefore called *Yahudis* and the rest of the descendants as *Bani Israel*. Later this distinction was removed and now *Bani Israel* and *Yahudis* are all referred as Jews.

Yaqoob's country was *Kanaan* (Palestine), but *Yusuf* (Joseph) who had reached Egypt as per God's will. See heading *Yusuf* where it is described that he had called his kith and kin to Egypt. Thus the *Bani Israel* were settled in Egypt and gradually turned into a nation by multiplying.

The Pharaoh's ruled Egypt. Pharaoh was the title of the Kings there and is not used for any particular Pharaoh. Egyptians worshipped many gods and “*Aamn Ra*” (the Sun god) was the biggest of their gods.

The kings of Egypt were thought to be the *awtaar* or representatives of the gods. They were called the *awtaar* of the Sun god. Three thousand years ago, thirty generations of the Pharaohs ruled Egypt. During the time of *Yusuf*, Hyksos' family ruled Egypt and they were called *Umalaqah*.

In Egypt the **Bani Israel** had started out as a respected lot but gradually they became subjugated by the Pharaohs and began to be treated like slaves. When oppression reached its peak, **Moosa**, who was a great messenger of Allah and a revolutionary, was born among them.

Though he was born in a family belonging to the subjugated **Bani Israel**, God arranged that he was brought up in the Pharaoh's palace and thus became aware of the ways of kings (28:7-13). From here he reached the area called **Madyan** (28:22) where he wedded.

On return from **Madyan** he was endowed with messenger-hood on the mount **Toor** (20:12-13) and he was directed to go to the Pharaohs and deliver the **Bani Israel** from oppression. Along with his brother **Haroon** he reached the Pharaoh (20:43-44, 28:34). There were battles (struggles) with the Pharaoh and his religious people and at last he came away with the **Bani Israel** to Palestine (20:77) and educated them there. God made the **Bani Israel** the lord of the east and west in that blessed land (7:137). According to the **Torah** he died in the land of **Mo'aab** at the age of 120 years. See **Istasnaa** (34:5). **Haroon** had died earlier. The Quran has not discussed these details as these are irrelevant.

He was succeeded by **Joshua** according to the Torah. Thereafter the nation of **Bani Israel** rose to new heights. This was the era in which the grandeur of **Dawood** and **Suleman** was inherited by them. Later they stopped following the way of Allah and ignominy pursued them.

They were first destroyed by **Bakht Nasar** of Babylon in 99 B.C. He demolished Jerusalem and enslaved the Jews and took them to Babylon. Within a hundred years three Persian kings i.e. Cyrus (**Zulqarnain**), **Dara** and **Artakhshashta** agreed to help them and they were able to come and settle once more in Jerusalem. Surah **Al-Bagrah** mentions this destruction and rehabilitation allegorically in verse (2:259). In 332 B.C. **Alexander** of Macedonia attacked their centre i.e. Jerusalem. Then in 320 B.C., **Batlimos** attacked them by way of **Egypt**. He attacked Jerusalem and seized it. During the period of **Antigonos**, this area came under the Greeks and the Jews were badly persecuted. In 66 B.C. their last destruction had begun to take place. Pompeii of Rome advanced towards Palestine and seized it. In this battle, about 12 thousand Jews were killed. Then in 01 B.C. in another battle, about thirty thousand Jews were enslaved. Allah tried to redeem them and sent **Isa** (Jesus) to them for salvation but the way he was treated by them is known to the whole world. After him the moment of reckoning for them had arrived. Titus, the Roman Governor attacked them so badly in 70 A.D that they were destroyed as a nation.

Surah **Bani Israel** talks about the first destruction at the hands of **Bakht Nasar** and this last destruction (17:4-7).

Moosa was Allah's messenger. He was endowed by Allah with a celestial Book:

2:52	Haroon was a messenger too, he too received the book	وَإِذَا آتَيْنَا مُوسَى الْكِتَابَ
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As such, about **Moosa** and **Haroon** it is said:

37:117	And We endowed both of them with a clear Book:	وَأَتَيْنَاهُمَا الْكِتَابَ الْمُسْتَبِينَ
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The Quran mentions no separate book for **Haroon** nor is it named (5:44), but Torah is actually the name of the group of books which were given from **Moosa** to **Isa** and all the messengers between them. This group of books is called "The Old Testament".

The Jews had defined it literally (4:46) and figuratively (2:75). Plus they had also made their own additions to it (2:79) and thus their religious book became a mixture of the truth and fabrication (3:71) and therefore bitter controversies had arisen over it (11:110). They were explained by the Quran when it made its advent (5:15). Also see heading **Torah**.

“أَمْوَالٌ” (*al-maal*) with its plural “أَمْوَالٌ” (*amwaaal*) means “everything which you possess”.

Ibnul Ayeer has said that actually “مَالٌ” (*maal*) means gold and silver in your possession. Later a collection of things in your possession also came to be called “مَالٌ” (*maal*), however the Arabs used to call their flock of camels “مَالٌ” (*maal*) because they were wealth to them.

“رَجُلٌ مِثْلٌ” (*rajulum maseel*): a very rich man.

“مُلْتُهُ” (*multuhu*): I gave him wealth.

“تَمَوَّلْتُ” (*tamaw'waltu*) and “اِسْتَمَلْتُ” (*istamaltu*): “I became rich”.

“مَوَّلَهُ” (*mawwalhu*): he made him wealthy {*T, M*}. Most scholars believe that the word “مَالٌ” (*maal*) is derived from the root (*M-W-L*), but *Raghib* has written it under “أَلْمَيْلُ” (*al-mayl*) with roots (*M-Y-L*) because he says wealth is called “مَالٌ” (*maal*) because it favours one for some time and then leaves him to go to another i.e. it doesn't stay with anyone permanently {*R*}. It is possible that wealth is called “مَالٌ” (*maal*) because to obtain it a man has to bend towards one direction. But if *Raghib's* research is correct then the plural of “مَالٌ” (*maal*) would be “أَمْيَالٌ” (*amyaaal*) and not “أَمْوَالٌ” (*amwaaal*) as it currently is.

To establish a divine system on earth man has to bear some losses in which “نَقْصٌ مِنَ الْأَمْوَالِ” (*naqsin minal amwaaal*) in (2:155) is included. That is the loss of wealth and riches. But after this the group of believers is made the owner of the wealth of the opponents and they enjoy proliferation of all kinds (33:27). Therefore the proliferation of wealth is the necessary result of establishing the divine system, and the benevolence of Allah. But the wealth that is under the charge of the system of sustenance for the entire nation (9:111) and if every individual collects wealth for his individual benefit then that wealth continues to prepare hellfire whose flames engulf the heart (104:72). The name of this system is Capitalism which the Quran has been sent to humanity to eliminate (9:34-35).

“مَاءٌ” (*ma'a*) was actually “مَوَّةٌ” (*mawat*), but gradually it turned into “مَاءٌ” (*ma'a*). It means “water”. The plural is “مِيَاهٌ” (*miyat*)

“مَاهِتِ السَّيْفِينِ” (*maahatis safinah*): the boat got filled with water.

“بَنُو مَاءِ السَّمَاءِ” (*banu maa-is sama*): this was the nick name for the Arabs who were always in quest of rainfall and went to whatever place, where rain water was to be found {*T, F*}.

The Quran says:

11:7	Allah's throne is on water	كَانَ عَرْشُهُ عَلَى الْمَاءِ
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For the meaning of this verse, see heading (*Ain-R-Sh*).

“مَهْدٌ” (*mahd*): to make a place smooth and soft.

“أَلْمَهْدُ” (*al-muhd*): soft and level ground.

“أَلْمِهَادُ” (*al-mihaad*): bed, because it is soft and smooth {*T*}.

“مِهَادًا” (*mihaada*): the earth (78:6), i.e. vast land that is spread out and is level or smooth.

“أَلْمَهْدُ” (*al-mahd*): a child's bed which is level and soft {*T*}.

“تَمْهيدُ الْأَمْرِ” (*tamheedul amr*): to smooth out some matter.

Taj-ul-Uroos with reference to *Raghib* says it figuratively also means “to expand or increase wealth and rank”. In other words, it means to make life soft and luxurious.

30:44	Whatever good deeds they do, provide them with luxuries and improve their lives	وَمَنْ عَمِلْ صَالِحًا فَلَا نَفْسِهِمْ يُهَدُونَ
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Surah *Al-Baghr* calls *jahannam* as “يَبْسُ الْمِهَادُ” (*bi’sal mihaad*) in (2:206). Here it means a place to stay or live in.

The Quran calls Allah as:

51:48	And We have spread out the earth, and a good provider of luxuries We are, or provider of an abode	وَالْأَرْضَ فَرَشْنَاهَا فَنِعْمَ الْمَاهِدُونَ
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Surah *Maryam* says that *Maryam* along with her son *Isa* came to the worshippers of Jewish temple. These worshippers got angry because in their opinion she had given up a life of celibacy and was living a normal marital life (as she had a child). In their opinion this was against the rule of monasticism.

Instead of replying, she pointed to the child (which was *Isa*) that he would answer them. At this, the priests said sarcastically:

19:26	How can we talk to someone who is inexperienced? (He is hence beneath our standards)	كَيْفَ نَكَلِّمُ مَنْ كَانَ فِي الْمَهْدِ صَبِيًّا
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This makes the meaning of “المهد” (*al-mahd*) as cradle clear.

This is the concept of “تكلم في المهد” (*takallum fil mahd*), i.e. talking about the universal truths at a young age, towards which has been pointed in (3:45, 5:110).

The reply that was given by *Isa* to the priests also shows that it was not a reply from the cradle, i.e. was not the reply of a child. *Isa* said:

19:30	I am on a mission of Allah. He has given me the Book, and made me a messenger	إِنِّي عَبْدُ اللَّهِ - آتَنِي الْكِتَابَ وَجَعَلَنِي نَبِيًّا -
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This shows that this is from a period when *Isa* has been endowed with messenger hood. For more details, see the book titled “*Shola-i-Mastoor*”.

M-He-L م ه ل

“الْمَهْلُ” (*al-mahl*), “الْمَهْلُ” (*al-mahal*), “الْمَهْلَةُ” (*al-muhlah*): peace, contentment, softness, “الْمَهْلَةُ” (*amhalah*): treated him softly or gently, did not treat him harshly, granted him more time, gave him more time.
 “تَمَهَّلَ فِي عَمَلِهِ” (*tamah hala fi amalihi*): he did not hasten in his work, did it peacefully and with equanimity.
 “الْمَهْلُ” (*al-mahl*): aplomb and honour, to proceed in a good deed.
 “الْمَاهِلُ” (*al-maahil*): fast, one who goes ahead {*T, R*}.

Surah *At-Talaq* says:

86:17	treat these opponents gently and give them some time	فَمَهْلِ الْكَافِرِينَ أَتَاهُمْ رُؤُودًا
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There is a time interval between the deeds and their effects to show up (16:61). This is what extending the time limit means. This takes place according to the Law of requital in the moral world.

Probably due to peace and stability, every metal is called “الْمَهْلُ” (*al-muhl*). Some say that it means molten zinc, copper or iron. Others think that it means olive oil and its dregs. Also this is supposed to mean ash and small bits of ambers which fall off bread when it is taken out of an oven. The *Aamir* tribe says it means poison, however the element of destruction is predominant in this word.

Surah *Al-Ma’arij* mentions this word in verse (70:8). Here if the word is taken to mean “molten metal” then it will be appropriate, i.e. the power of great leaders will turn to water or nought. The water that will be provided to those in *jahannam* will be like “” (*muhl*). Here if the word is taken to mean “poison” then too it will be appropriate and if it is taken to mean “molten lava” then too it will be fine.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:26	Things that support life will also prove deadly for them.	يُعَاثُّونَا بِمَا كَانُوا يَكْفُرُونَ
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Mahma مَهْمَا

“مَهْمَا” (*mahma*): anything. Some think that “مَهْمَا” (*mahma*) is a compound of “مَا” (*maa*) and “مَا” (*maa*), but “ا” (*A*) of the first “مَا” (*ma*) has been changed to “هـ” (*he*).

7:132	they said whatever signs you bring	وَقَالُوا مَهْمَا تَأْتِنَا بِهِ مِنْ آيَةٍ
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M-He-N م ه ن

“مَاهِنَةً” (*mahana*): he used it very well, exploited it fully.
 “إِمْتَاهِنَةً” (*imtahanahu*): he employed it in his service and thus weakened it.
 “الْمَاهِنُ” (*al-maheen*): a camel which has been so weakened with hard labour that it is not useful to sire a camel so that their children may not be born weak as well.
 “الْمَاهِنُ” (*al-maahin*): slave and servant.
 “الْمِهْنَةُ” (*al-mihnah*): cleverness and expertise in serving.
 “الْمِهْنَةُ مِنَ الرَّجَالِ” (*al-maheenu minar rajul*): lowly being, mean man of unimportant opinion and of weak manners {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means non importance or insignificance and hatred.

The Quran has said:

32:8	(the creation of man happens through) weak and insignificant liquid that is ejaculated (sperm)	سُلِّلَتْ مِنْ مَّاءٍ مَهِينٍ
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This has been said as a comparison, i.e. to create such a fine human being out of this insignificant water is a manifestation of God’s creative power.

M-Y-D م ي د

“مَادَّ قَوْمَهُ” (*maada qaumahu*): he brought food for his nation
 “مَادَّاهُمْ” (*maadahum*), “يَمِيدُهُمْ” (*yameeduhum*): gave them the goods of sustenance.
 “الْمُمْتَادُّ” (*al-mumtaad*): someone who takes the goods of sustenance.
 “مِدَّتُهُ” (*midtuhu*) and “وَأَمَدَّتُهُ” (*amidtuhu*): I granted him.
 “مَادَّنِي فُلَانٌ” (*maadani fulaan*): he did me a favour {*T*}. *Raghib* says it also means “he fed me”
 “مَادَّ” (*maada*): to move with intensity. It also means “to bend”.
 “مَادَّتْ بِهِ الْأَرْضُ” (*maadat bihil ardu*): the earth revolved along with it.
 “الْمَاعِدَةُ” (*al-maa'idah*): food, no matter if a spread accompanies it or not. Some scholars say it means a spread on which there is food. If no food is spread out then the spread is called “خَوَانٌ” (*khwaan*).

Abu Abeer says the spread is called “مِدَّةٌ” (*maa'idah*) because it is given to the guest as a gift and favour {*T*}. *Ibn Faris* says the basic meanings of these words are “movement” and “to benefit”.

5:112	He should endow us with the spread from the sky	أَنْ يُنَزِّلَ عَلَيْنَا مَائِدَةً مِنَ السَّمَاءِ
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Like every messenger *Isa* too told the people that if they followed the laws of Allah, then He would grant them good sustenance and successes in this world. But the way that nation was facing difficulties

indicated that it could never get the accoutrements of life in abundance. So he felt that these people should be free of bondage to human beings for their sustenance and get it directly from Allah. Then perhaps they would change their ways and follow Allah's laws.

Isa said to his followers that “you are *momins* and you should observe Allah's laws” (5:112). Allah said that He would create such a system (whereby they would get sustenance directly from Allah, i.e. this would be the definite result of their following.

5:115	Anyone who rebels even after this (sustenance directly from Allah), would meet harsh punishment	فَمَنْ يَكْفُرْ بَعْدُ مِنْكُمْ فَإِنِّي أُعَذِّبُهُ عَذَابًا
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As such, “مَائِدَةٌ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ” (*maa'idatan minas sama'i*) is the second name for the system of sustenance and the definite result of “” (*taqwa*). This is the gist of the verses, not the exact translation.

Surah *Al-Nahal* says about the earth:

16:15	live on it in peace and let it revolve with you all	أَنْ تَمِيدَ بِكُمْ
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An open and vast space is called “الْمَيْدَانُ” (*al-maidaan*) or “الْمَيْدَانُ” (*al-meedaan*). Therefore “مَائِدَةٌ” (*maa'idah*) also has the element of vastness or openness.

M-Y-R م ي ر

“الْمَيْرَةُ” (*al-meerah*): edibles which somebody carries over.

“مَارَ عِيَالَهُ يَمِيرُ” (*maara iyaalahu yameeru maira*): he brought edibles for his family {*T, M*}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:65	We will bring grains (or foodstuff) for our family	وَيَمِيرُ أَهْلَنَا
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M-Y-Z م ي ز

“مَارَ” (*maaza*), “يَمِيرُ” (*yameez*): to separate something, to single out.

“فَامْتَاَزَ” (*famtaaz*): so the thing was separated {*T, M*}.

Raghib says it means “to separate things that look alike” {*R*}

The Quran says:

3:178	until Allah separates the pure from the impure	حَتَّى يَمَيِّزَ الْخَبِيثَ مِنَ الطَّيِّبِ
36:59	O you criminals, be separated now	وَأَمْتَاَزُوا لِيَوْمَ آيَئِهَا الْمُجْرِمُونَ
67:8	he is near explosion due to passion	تَكَادُ تَمَيِّزُ مِنَ الْغَيْظِ

“تَمَيِّزُ” (*tamayyaz*): to become separate.

“تَمَيِّزَ الرَّجُلُ مِنَ الْغَيْظِ” (*tamayyazar rajulu minal ghaiz*): due to anger he broke into pieces {*T, M*}.

“الْتَمَيِّزُ” (*at-tameez*): to distinguish between similar things {*R*}.

Meekaal مَيْكَال

Surah *Al-Bagrah* mentions “جِبْرِيلَ” (*Jibreel*) and “مِيكَالَ” (*Meekaal*) in (2:98). The Jews consider the angel *Meekaal* (Michael) to be friendly.

“مَالَ” (*maal*): he bent.

“مَالَ إِلَيْهِ” (*maala ilaih*): he bent or leaned towards him, was attracted to him, was attentive to him.

“مَالَ عَلَيْهِ” (*maala alaih*): he leaned against him, oppressed him, or attacked him (4:102).

“مَالَ عَنِ الْحَقِّ” (*maala unil haqq*): he left the path of justice, or avoided it.

“أَمَّالَهُ” (*amaalahu*): bent it, made it bow.

“مَالَتِ الشَّمْسُ” (*maalatish shams*): the sun leaned towards the west, started setting.

“مَيَّلَ بَيْنَ الْأَمْرَيْنِ” (*mayyala bainal amrain*): he was divided between two deeds as to which to perform, i.e. his heart bent to one thing first then to another to perform {T}.

“مَيْلَةً” (*mailah*): to bend once {T}.

“أَلْمَيْلُ” (*al-meel*): a mile, or a fixed distance on land. There is difference of opinion as to its length. It can mean a light house, an unlimited distance on land, or the needle of a blackish substance applied to the eyes to make them look beautiful and healthy {T}.

Raghib has listed “أَلْمَالُ” (*al-maal*) under “مَيْلٌ” (*meil*) and said that “مَالَ” (*maal*) is said so because it is bent towards one sometime and then to another, i.e. “مَالَ” (*maal*) or wealth keeps changing hands {R}, but I have not agreed to this interpretation. See heading (M-W-L).

See heading (N-W-N)

“نَأَيْتُهُ” (*na aituhu*), “نَأَيْتُ عَنْهُ” (*na aitu unhu*): I distanced myself from him.
 “نَأَى بِه” (*naaya bihi*): removed him to one side, distanced him, moved him {T}.

The Quran says:

4:26	they stay away from it (the Quran) and keep others too away from it	وَهُمْ يَنْهَوْنَ عَنْهُ وَيَنْعَوْنَ عَنْهُ
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“الْمُنْتَأَى” (*al-munta'aa*): a distant place.
 “النَّأَى” (*an-naayu*): a ditch which is dug around a tent so that rain water does not come into the tent, but stays away from it. This also means separation {T}, as well as “to ignore” {R, F}.

The Quran says:

17:38	Took himself away while abiding and being rebellious, avoided it.	أَعْرَضَ وَ نَأَى بِجَانِبِهِ
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“نَأَى فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*naaya fil ard*): he went afar in the country {T}.

1) This pronoun (for two) appears for every plural, masculine and feminine i.e. for all.

2) It appears for first person plural and is used both as masculine and feminine
 “أَضَلَّانَا” (*azzal laana*): these two misled us.

3) It appears for speakers.
 “رَبَّنَا” (*rabbana*): O, our Lord.

The Quran says:

41:29	and those who are kaffir will say “O, our Lord, show us those (point to us) among men and <i>Djinn</i> who misled us”	وَقَالَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا رَبَّنَا أَرَنَا الَّذِينَ أَضَلَّانَا مِنَ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسِ
14:45	what deal we cut with them ...	كَيْفَ فَعَلْنَا بِهِمْ

Ibn Faris says it basically means to come to one place from another.

“نَبَأٌ” (*naba'un*): to give the news.
 “نَبَأٌ” (*naba'u*): “news” because it travels from one place to another.

Raghib says “نَبَأٌ” (*naba'u*) is not any news but that which is beneficial and which is knowledgeable or at least which makes the listener aware. This piece of news must be free of lies, like news given by God or the Messenger {T, L}, but this rule is not correct.

The Quran says:

29:4	If some mischievous person brings you some news, then investigate it (whether that is true)	إِنْ جَاءَكُمْ فَاسِقٌ بِنَبَأٍ فَتَبَيَّنُوهُ
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Here a news item brought by a “فاسق” (*faasiq*) is also called “نَبَأٌ” (*naba’un*).

“أَنْبَأَ” (*anba’a*) and “نَبَّأَ” (*nabba’a*) mean to give news {*T, L*}.

“نَبَّيْتُ عِبَادِي” (*nabbi ibaadi*): tell my servants for a fact (15:49).

“وَأَتْلُ عَلَيْنِهِمْ نَبَأَ إِبْرَاهِيمَ” (*watlu alihim naba’a Ibrahim*): tell them about the news (tales) of *Ibrahim* (26:69).

“نَبَّأَ” (*naba’a*), “نَبُوْءٌ” (*nabu’un*): to rise or a high ground as a plateau.

“الْأَنْبَاءُ” (*an-nab’ah*): high land.

“الْأَنْبِيَاءُ” (*an-nabi*): a plateau or evident path which rises to be evident {*T, L*}.

In Arabic language, there also is a word called “نَبُو” (*nabu*) based on root (*N-B-W*).

“نَبَّوْا” (*nabwun*) and “نَبَّوْهُ” (*nabwah*) means to rise, be lofty, to be a plateau {*T, F*}.

“الْأَنْبَاؤُ” (*an-naba’a*): land which is higher than other lands. It also means “lofty landmark which gives guidance” {*T, L*}.

The Quran has used the word “الْأَنْبِيَاءُ” (*an-nabiyyu*) to mean “messenger”. Some think that it is derived from the word “نَبَأٌ” (*naba’u*) and therefore means “one who gives news”, but this is a concept propagated by the Torah. *Nabi* was the name of a particular rank of an official of the religious order of the Jews, who used to make predictions. That is why in English, *nabi* is translated as prophet, i.e. one who makes prophecies. But from the Quranic concept of messenger-hood or “نَبَاوَةٌ” (*nabuwwat*), one can see that it is derived from “نَبَّوْهُ” (*nabawah*) which means a lofty place. Thus “نَبِيٌّ” (*nabi*) means “someone who is at a higher place where he can see things clearly”.

Kitab-al-Ashqaaq says that a person called out to the Messenger *Muhammed* as “نَبِيَّ اللَّهِ” (*nabi-allah*) since he meant that the word “نَبِيٌّ” (*nabi*) had been derived from “نَبَأٌ” (*naba’a*), but the Messenger said: “لَسْتُ بِنَبِيٍّ ءِ اللَّهِ وَلَكِنْ نَبِيُّ اللَّهِ” (*lastu binabi –il laahi wala kin nabi-ullah*) which means “I am not a *nabi*’ of Allah, but a *nabi* sent by Allah.

This shows that this word has been derived from “نَبَّوْهُ” (*nabawah*) which means someone who stands at the lofty place where he is shown both the real and meta-physical universe. He can witness the basic truths of the universe on one hand through the revelation, and delivers these truths to the human world on the other hand. He then implements these truths in the real world of humans.

This was the fact that the Messenger *Muhammed* made when he announced his messenger-hood to the Quresh tribe of *Mecca*. He stood on a high place and asked the people whether they would believe him if he said that a forceful army was ready to attack them from the other side of the mountain? They said surely they would believe him because he had never lied in his life, and also because he was standing at a point where he could see on the other side of the mountain as well and tell what was transpiring. He said “then believe me when I say that your deeds are advancing towards you as a forceful army of destructive results and hence you should give up this way of life and adopt the righteous way”.

This depicts the right picture about “نَبَاوَةٌ” (*nabuwwat*), i.e. the *nabi* (the messenger) is placed at the high place of knowledge where he (through the revelation) witnesses the truths about the universe. This is the right place of “نَبَاوَةٌ” (*nabuwwat*). Then he comes to the people with this knowledge of the revelation so that the people are made aware about the truth, and practically demonstrates how to live as per the Quranic guidance.

This is the duty of a “نَبِيٌّ” (*nabi*), i.e. to deliver the revelation to people. This process ended with the messenger *Muhammed*. Now no human being can receive the revelation from God, because whatever guidance was needed has already been given and contained in the Quran.

As far as the duty of messenger-hood is concerned i.e. demonstrating on how to act according to the revealed guidance and transmitting it to others, this duty was entrusted (after the Messenger **Muhammed**) to the nation or followers who have inherited the Book of Allah. It will be called “تبليغ” (*tableegh*) i.e. accepting the Quranic guidance and then communicating to others for their own good and “اقامت دين” (*aqamat-e-deen*) and not “رسالت” (*risalah*) because “رسالت” (*risalah*) can produce confusion as the use of word messenger can be misconstrued. This system will continue till the last man on this planet.

“نبي” (*nabi*) and “رسالت” (*risalah*) is enshrined in one and the same person therefore every “نبي” (*nabi*) is a “رسول” (*rasul*) and every “رسول” (*rasul*) is a “نبي” (*nabi*). After the termination of the messenger-hood, there can be no messenger now as the Quran is a complete book of guidance. But the duty of taking the message of Allah to others now lies with those who willingly accept and understand the message. Indeed the accepting and benefitting from the guidance produces an inner conviction and a desire to share it with fellow beings for the good of wider mankind. Therefore the group of people who accept the message wherever they are, become the heir to the messenger and willingly take on the duties of passing this message to others. The messenger-hood of **Muhammed** is safe in the Quran and the ‘duty of taking the guidance to others will lie with the momineen wherever they are till the end of time.

Generally it is thought that **Rasul** is a messenger which is given a Book by God and **Nabi** is a messenger who is given no book. This is a wrong concept and is due to absence of an understanding. The Quran has clearly said that Allah gave a book to all messengers (2:213). The same phrase has been used for the **Rasuls** (57:25). These very books of the **Nabis** have been called “وَأَنْزَلَ مَعَهُمُ الْكِتَابَ بِالْحَقِّ” (*ma ootiyān nabiyyuna mir rabbihim*) in (2:123). People have been invited to have faith on them.

Isa had said:

19:30	Allah has given me the Book and declared me a messenger (<i>nabi</i>).	أَتَيْنِي الْكِتَابَ وَجَعَلَنِي نَبِيًّا
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These explanations show that every **nabi** is given the Book of guidance. As mentioned earlier “نباوة” (*nabuwat*) and “رسالت” (*risalat*) are two faces of the same coin. Thus the **Nabis** have been called **Nabi** at some place and people have been asked to follow them (65:1), and **Rasul** at other places (48:29), so much so that about **Ismail** it has been said:

19:54	A messenger whom we had endowed with messenger hood	وَكَانَ رَسُولًا نَبِيًّا
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The end of messenger-hood means that nobody can receive knowledge directly from God anymore as it is not required. Whatever knowledge for the human guidance was meant to be revealed through the revelation has been completed and is now safe in the Quran -. Therefore the concept of receiving knowledge directly from God through meditation is contradictory to the concept of “The end of messenger-hood”.

We have said earlier that the word “نبي” (*nabi*) is derived from “نباوة” (*nabawah*), but if it is held to have been derived from “نبا” (*naba'un*) then too it will encompass the connotations of high rank and making knowledgeable about things of which are unknown. This would mean that this “unknown knowledge” can only be received via revelation to messengers from God, rather than predictions, claimants to which are found even among the non-Muslims. See heading (*Gh-Y-B*).

N-B-T

ن ب ت

“النَّبَاتُ” (*an-nabt*), “النَّبَاتُ” (*an-nabaat*): anything that grows from the earth {R}.
“الْمُنْبِتُ” (*al-munbit*): the place to grow.

This root also has the connotation of being growing, appearing, and evident.

“نَبَتْ تَدَى الْجَارِيَةِ” (*alled nabata sadul jaariyah*): for a girl’s chest to become evident or developed.
“نَبَتْ عَانَةُ الْعَلَامِ” (*nabatat aanahu ghulaam*): for a boy to attain maturity.

“أَنْبَتَ الْغُلَامُ” (*anbatal ghulam*): for a young boy to attain maturity
 “التَّنْبِيْتُ” (*at-tanbaitu*): to nurture, upbringing {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means “growth” in something.

The Quran says:

22:5	The earth grows all kinds of good things	وَأَنْبَتَتْ مِنْ كُلِّ نَوْعٍ مَحْشِرًا
3:36	(her <i>Sustainer</i>) brought her (<i>Mariam</i>) up very well	وَأَنْبَتَهَا نَبَاتًا حَسَنًا

Here the physical upbringing of *Mariam*, as well as moral upbringing is referred.

About mankind it is said:

71:17	Allah nurtures you or brings you up like the plants	وَاللَّهُ أَنْبَتَكُمْ مِنَ الْأَرْضِ نَبَاتًا
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It can also mean that Allah has spread mankind over the earth like the branches of a tree which have one trunk and root. It also means figuratively that Allah has raised man from the earth like he nurtures the plants – in any case the physical life wholly depends on what comes out of the earth. At other places in the Quran it is said that man has been created initially from earth, and thereafter the whole thing advanced. Details about the creation of *Man and the Evolution Theory* can be found in the book titled *Adam and Iblees*.

N-B-Dh

ن ب ذ

Ibn Faris says it basically means to throw away or put away.

“نَبَذَ” (*nabaz*): to throw something away because it is found to be valueless.

“الْمُنْبُذُ” (*al-munbuz*): a child which has been abandoned on the road {T, R} (i.e. an illegal birth).

Therefore it means something that is not valued or hated because it is valueless.

“نَبَذَ الْعَهْدَ” (*nabazal ahd*): violated the agreement.

“نَبَذَ الْأَمْرَ” (*nabazal amr*): to leave something useless {M}.

“الْإِنْتِبَازُ” (*al-intibaaz*): to move to one side, to give up on (19:16).

“النَّبْذُ” (*an-nabz*): to put dates or dried grapes with water to one side so that they become “نَبِيزٌ” (*nabeez*) or filled with water {M}.

104:4	capitalist and all their wealth will remain (behind) as valueless	كُلًّا لَيُنْبَذَنَّ فِي الْحُطَمَةِ
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For the meaning of “حُطَمَةٌ” (*hutamah*), see heading (*H-T-M*).

Surah *Al-Anfaal* says about the pacts between nations:

8:85	if you fear violation of agreement from some nation then if you are equal to them then lay down the agreement to one side	وَإِنَّمَا تَخَافُونَ مِنْ قَوْمٍ خِيَانَةً فَانْصِرُوا إِلَيْهِمْ عَلَىٰ سَوَاءٍ
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It means that you must not violate an agreement simply on apprehensions of violation from the other side, neither think of hurting them, but as you dealt with them while making the agreement, tell them clearly that you have no more faith in them and therefore we will no more abide by any agreement.

“عَلَىٰ سَوَاءٍ” (*ala sawa-inn*): treat them as equals or if in breaking the agreement suddenly they stand to bear some loss, then justice demands that they be spared this loss. This justifiable approach can only be advocated by the Quran.

Conversely, before the advent of Islam those with the book would:

2:100	whenever they entered into an agreement then one group would debunk the agreement	أَوْكَلَمَا عَهْدُوا عَهْدًا نَبَذَهُ فَرِيقٌ مِنْهُمْ
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These verses clearly denote the difference between “نَبَذَ” (*nabaza*) and “نَبَذَ عَلَى سَوَاءٍ” (*nabaza ala sawainn*).

- “النَّبْرُ” (*an-nabz*): to characterise someone (negative connotation), give somebody a bad nickname.
 “التَّنَابُزُ” (*at-tanaabooz*): to shame one another, to call each other by shameful nicknames.
 “النَّبِيزُ” (*an-nabeez*): to have disagreeable names for each other.
 “النَّبِزُ” (*an-nibz*): the upper covering of a date palm {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

49:11	Do not call each other by sarcastic and hateful names	وَلَا تَنَابَزُوا بِالْأَلْقَابِ
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This also means not to think on these lines in the first place as our thoughts precede our actions and as per the Quran we must be aware of our thoughts on a continuous basis e.g. (11:5).

- “النَّبْطُ” (*an-nabat*): when water is initially struck while digging a well.
 “أَنْبَطَ الْحَافِرُ” (*ambatil haafir*): the digger reached the water while digging. It also means to dig something out and make it evident {*T*}, or to reach the truth after investigation and then make it evident.

The Quran says:

4:83	Those among them who can reach the truth after investigation.	الَّذِينَ يَسْتَنْبِطُونَهُ مِنْهُمْ
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Zajaaj says the word means conclusion {*T*}.

Ibn Faris too says this is what it means, i.e. to draw conclusion from the available facts or to reach its basics or bottom line.

- “النَّبْعُ” (*an-naba*): to gush forth from the spring.
 “الْيَنْبُوعُ” (*al-yanbuuh*): spring, fountainhead, the place from where the water comes out.
 “يَنْبَائِعُ” (*yanabih*): plural form.
 “مَنْبَعُ الْمَاءِ” (*manba-ul maa-ee*): fountainhead {*T*}.

The Quran says:

17:90	bring forth a spring from this land for us	تَفْخُرْ لَنَا مِنَ الْأَرْضِ يَنْبُوعًا
39:21	then let it (water) flow as springs on the land	فَسَلَكَهُ يَنْبَائِعُ فِي الْأَرْضِ

- “النَّتَقُ” (*nataq*), “يَنْتَقُ” (*yantiq*), “يَنْتُقُ” (*yantuq*): to move something violently or to shake {*T*}.

7:171	when We shook the mount that was towering over them	وَ إِذْ نَفَثْنَا الْجَبَلَ فَوْقَهُمْ
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“النَّاتِقُ مِنَ الْخَيْلِ” (*un naatiqu minal khail*): the horse which gives its rider a very rough ride, or throws him off his back.

“النَّتَقُ” (*un natq*): to shake off and to uproot {*T*}. These are all instances of movements of sorts

Raghib says it means “to pull something so that it becomes loose”.

Ibn Faris says this word means “to pull, to shake or uproot”.

“نَثَرَ” (*nasar*), “يَنْثُرُ” (*yansur*), “نَثَرًا” (*nasran*) and “نِثَارًا” (*nisaara*): to scatter something.

“فَانْتَثَرَ” (*fantasar*): so it was scattered.

“النَّثَرُ” (*un-nasar*): to disseminate secrets, to talk too much.

“الْمُنْتَثِرُ” (*al-muntassar*): a weak man who has no good points in him.

“الْمِنْثَارُ” (*al-minsar*): a date palm out of which unripe dates fall off, i.e. the fruit falls off even when it is unripe and is therefore useless {*T, M, R*}.

About the deeds of criminals the Quran says:

25:23	We will render them without any result and useless	فَجَعَلْنَاهُمْ هَبَاءً مَنْثُورًا
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In the scales of the Law of requital they will carry no weight. They will disintegrate in air, i.e. they will not be able to produce any constructive results (this is what result-less means) e.g. (18:105).

Surah *Al-Infitaar* says:

82:2	When the stars will scatter (when they will be scattered around)	إِذَا الْكَوَاكِبُ انْتَثَرَتْ
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“النَّجْدُ” (*un-najd*): the part of land which is high and hard. It also means “high and open road” and “an expert leader” {*T, R*}.

“نَجَدَ الْأَمْرُ يَنْجُدُ” (*najadal amru yanjud*): the matter became evident and was disclosed {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

90:10	we showed man both the paths (of truth and falsehood)	وَهَدَيْنَاهُ النَّجْدَيْنِ
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Thereafter he has the right to choose (free will) whichever path he wants

The paths of truth and falsehood have been shown by the Revelation. Man inherently does not have the ability to distinguish between right and wrong without the help of the Revelation. See heading (*L-He- M*) and (*F-Te-R*).

Also only Allah shows the way, through the Revelation, but does not makes one choose the right way. It is up to man himself to choose the right or wrong path. This makes man responsible for every deed he performs and by judging these very deeds he can be said to be on the wrong or the right path. The Quran has clearly sign posted both the paths and we can judge our thoughts and deeds using the criterion explained in the book. The change in our thinking and our conduct in the light of the Quran can be compared and contrasted with our past and with others especially who do not follow the guidance.

“النَّجَسُ” (*an-najas*): it is the opposite of pure, i.e. “impure”. See heading (*Te-He-R*).

“قَدْ نَجَسَ ثَوْبُهُ” (*qad najis saubih*): his cloth was soiled, became impure.

Raghib says there is impurity which can be seen with the eyes, i.e. physical and the other which can be felt with insight like the impurity of inner self.

In these meanings the Quran has said:

9:28	those who attribute divinity to others are surely full of impurities (e.g. weaknesses)	إِنَّمَا الْمُشْرِكُونَ نَجَسٌ
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“دَائِي نَاجِسٌ” (*da'un naajis*): a sickness from which one cannot recover {*T*}.

The Arabs used to make their children wear a *taaweez* (a sort of holy charm) to drive away evil from them. These *taaweez* were generally comprised of impure things, such as the bones of the dead or the cloth which had been used to clean menstruation. These were called “النَّجِيسُ” (*at-tanjees*) {*Gharib-ul-Quran*}.

It is also possible that since this act was done to drive away evil forces, it was called “النَّجِيسُ” (*at-tanjees*).

N-J-M

ن ج م

“النَّجْمُ” (*an-najm*): a star when it can be seen. The plural is “النُّجُومُ” (*anjum*) or “نُجُومٌ” (*nujum*). It also means a plant without a trunk or stalk and which spreads out on the ground {*T, M*}.

55:6	And the stars and the trees both prostrate	النَّجْمُ وَالشَّجَرُ يَسْجُدَانِ
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Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is “to appear” and “to be evident”.

“النَّجْمَةُ” (*un-najmah*): sentence {*T, M*}.

“النَّجْمُ” (*an-najmah*) is generally used to term the gradual revelation of the Quran {*T, M*} but the Quran has not used it to mean this.

“نَظَرَ فِي الْأَمْرِ” (*nazara fil amr*): to deliberate on a matter as to what to do about it.

Surah *Al-Sa'afaat* says:

37:88	Then he glanced a glance at the starts	فَنَظَرَ نَظْرَةً فِي النُّجُومِ
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Here it means “to deliberate” {*T*}, but I think that the right meaning is the one which I have mentioned under the heading (*N-Z-R*), i.e. to criticize or to find fault.

The *Gharib-ul-Quran* says that “النَّجْمُ” (*an-nujum*) means the elite of a nation or small states, as against “الْأَشْمُسُ” (*ash-shams*) which e.g. at the time meant the state of Persia (81:102). In today's term we can relate it to super power(s) of present time.

N-J-W

ن ج و

“نَجَاءٌ” (*naja-un*), “نَجَاتٌ” (*najatun*), “نَجَايَاهُ” (*najayah*): to be protected from something that is dangerous.

Some say that it has been derived from “نَجْوَةٌ” (*najwah*) which means “high place” or “height”.

“النَّجْوَةُ وَالْمُنْجَى” (*an-najwatu walmunja*): the high place which is safe from flood waters due to its height.

Raghib says “النَّجْوَةُ وَالنَّجَاةُ” (*an-najwatun wun nijaat*) means a place which is distinguished from its environment due to its height {*T, M*}.

“نَجَا” (*naja*), “يَنْجُو” (*yanju*), “نَجَاءٌ” (*naja'un*): to walk past and fast.

A Hadith says “إِذَا سَافَرْتُمْ فِي الْجُدُوبِ فَاسْتَنْجُوا” (*iza saafartum fil judubati fas tanju*): when you pass through dry or drought high land then go through it quickly (included just to explain the meaning of the root).

“نَاقَةٌ نَاجِيَةٌ” (*naaqatun naajiyah*): a fast paced camel {*T, M*}.

Raghib says that “نَجَاءٌ” (*naja'a*) actually means for something to be separate: come apart.

”تَجَا غُصُونُ الشَّجَرَةِ“ (*nafa ghusunash shajaratah*): cut the branches of the tree.
”تَجَا الْجِلْدَ“ (*najal jild*): pulled the skin {T, M}.

Ibn Faris has given two meanings for this word which are opposite to each other.

- 1) To pare something off and open it and
- 2) To hide, but at the same time he has said that it (the word) should be used concerning height.

Keeping the basic meanings in mind, one can glean the Quranic meaning of this word. Other religions present the concept that man is imprisoned in the prison that this world is.

The Hindu religion believes that man has come into this world to atone for the sins in his former life, to be liberated from this punishment is ”نَجَاةً“ (*nijaat*). To liberate from it is ”نَجَاةً“ (*nijaat*).

The Christians believe that every child of man comes into this world accompanied by the sins of the first father and mother, and he cannot be freed of these sins till he believes in the atonement of Christ.

Vedaant or the belief of the Hindus is that the human soul has been separated from its whole and is therefore anguished. For this part to be reunited with the whole is ”نَجَاةً“ (*nijaat*) or deliverance. A similar concept is harboured by the Buddhists who believe that every wish or desire is the forerunner of some calamity and by giving up desires a man can be free of these calamities. They call it **nirwaan** briefly. The religion says that man before coming to this was in a good state. He was engulfed by calamities when he entered this world. Now to be free of these difficulties and to regain his former state is the purpose of life.

The Quran categorically refutes all these concepts and declares such beliefs as chains which affect the human conduct and prevents them from using their potentials to the maximum (7:157). It says man does not enter this world either to atone for his former sins nor is burdened with the sins of his first parents when he enters the world. The world is not a prison, liberation from which is the purpose of life. The human soul is not part of God and reuniting with it after getting out of the quagmire of materialism is not the ultimate goal. It says instead that the human child is born with a clean slate, but it has immense realizable potentiality to make these potentialities a reality, and that is the purpose of human life so that it can evolve to a higher form of life through his own efforts. The purpose of life is not being ‘as you were’. Life is for living and developing and getting ahead. The life on the earth is man’s training ground. Here his personality develops where he can find all the happy things of life and this life also prepares him for the next evolutionary step. Therefore to be free of this world is not the purpose of life. To conquer the forces of this world and obtain the good things of life in a manner ordained by the laws of Allah so that his own personality is developed and the betterment of mankind is achieved, is the real purpose of life.

Skirmishes with the forces of evil are essential in this life. This very struggle solidifies and accentuates the human personality. The group or nation which lives as per Allah’s laws is kept free of oppressing forces and free from destruction.

For this the Quran has used the word ”نَجَاةً“ (*nijaat*). Sometimes it so happens that a nation falls into the grip of oppressive forces because of its wrong ways, but after that reverts back to the laws of Allah, it is delivered from these oppressive forces. Here too the word ”نَجَاةً“ (*nijaat*) is used. Just like this the Bani Israel got ”نَجَاةً“ (*nijaat*) from the Pharaoh’s oppression.

As far as ”نَجَاةً“ (*nijaat*) from **jahannam** after death is concerned, the Jews have the concept that due to the sins of their forefathers they will be put in **jahannam** only for some time, but after they have paid for their sins i.e. when the impurities are removed from them, they will be put in heaven (3:23). They think that they will go to **jahannam** for some time, or if they live a pure life then they will go to heaven. This they think is ”نَجَاةً“ (*nijaat*). These two concepts are also against the Quran.

According to the Quran man is not put in **jahannam** for a limited time’s punishment, nor is **jahannam** a laundry where sins are washed away so that then man can enter the **jannat** in a pure state.

The Quran’s concept is that when man lives as per the revelation and his potentials are developed enough to evolve to the next stage, then it is called a life of **jannat** or heaven, but if he lives a life according to

other laws than the revelation, then his development ceases, and it is called a life of **jahannum**. He, whose development ceases, is not capable of traversing the evolutionary stages of mankind and is unable to go to the next stage of development i.e. the life in the hereafter. He stays stagnant at one place {T}.

Note that a life of heaven or hell exists in this life too and in the life hereafter also. Here the life of hell and heaven that is being mentioned is in the life hereafter. Therefore, there is no question of ever getting out of **jahannam**. As such, the concept that man will spend some time in **jahannam** and thereafter having atoned for his sins (or his parents' sins) he will go to heaven, is also proven false as per the Quran. Details about **jahannam** and **jannat** will be found under relevant headings.

“نَجْوَى” (**najwaa**): to whisper secretly.

Raghib says it means to whisper because people used to conspire secretly out of town.

Some say that it has been derived from “نَجْوَى” (**najwaa**), therefore “نَجَاةً” (**najaat**) would mean to help each other in getting rid of some misery.

“إِنْتَجَى” (**intaja**): to sit at some high place {T}.

“نَجِيٍّ” (**najiyyi**): someone who shares a secret (19:52).

“نَاجِيٍّ” (**naaja**): confidante.

“تَنَاجِيًّا” (**tanaaji**): to whisper mutually.

“نَجْوَى” (**najwa**): a secret, and secret consultations (58:7, 20:62).

Surah **Yunus** says about the drowning of the Pharaoh:

10:92	Although Pharaoh was drowned, his body or corpse was preserved so that it could be a lesson to later generations.	فَالْيَوْمَ تُنْجِيكَ رَبِّي وَتَكُونُ لِمَنْ خَلَقَ آيَةً
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Kitaabal Ashqaaq says that here “تَنْجِيكَ” (**nunajjik**) means “to throw at some high place”.

From the pyramids of Egypt, corpses have been discovered in which the Pharaoh of the times of **Moosa** is also found. Since this is a relatively recent discovery, therefore the writers and historians (from the past) of the Quran could not earlier translate this verse correctly. This is the reason that even **Kitaabal Ashqaaq** translates the word “بَدَنٌ” (**badan**) as meaning armour, i.e. the Pharaoh's armour was thrown out of the water, at some high place, but the recent discovery has made it clear that it here means the Pharaoh's corpse {T}.

About its own facts, the Quran says that as more discoveries are made in man's person (human self and psyche) as well as in the universe, the Quranic truths will be proven through evidence (41:53). One way these facts come to light is for historic truths to be discovered, like the Pharaoh's corpse.

N-H-B

ن ح ب

“النَّهْبُ” (**an-nahb**): the pledge about which it is decided that it is compulsory {R}.

“نَحَبَ الرَّجُلِ يَنْحُبُ” (**najabar rajulu yanhub**): the man made a pledge {M}.

“التَّنْحَبُ” (**at-tanheeb**): to work diligently and continuously.

“النَّحْبُ” (**an-nahb**): death, gambling and games of chance, because in the latter wagers are made which must be fulfilled compulsorily.

“النَّحْبُ” (**an-nahb**): great danger, or to cry loudly {T} {Lissan-ul-Arab}.

Ibn Faris too says these are the meanings.

The Quran says:

33:23	These include those who have fulfilled their pledge, and	فَمِنْهُمْ مَنْ قَضَىٰ نَحْبَهُ
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	gave their life for the truth.	
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“تَحَتَّ” (*nahata*), “يَنْحُتُ” (*yanhutu*) and “يَنْحِتُ” (*yanhit*): to pare something and make smooth {*T*}.
 “الْنَحْتُ” (*an-naht*): for a carpenter to pare wood {*Lissan-ul-Arab*}.

The Quran says:

7:74	You build houses by cutting and paring the mountains.	وَتَنْحِتُونَ الْجِبَالَ بُيُوتًا
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“نَحْرُ الصَّدْرِ” (*nahrus sadr*): the upper part of the chest, the part of the chest where a garland is worn.
 “نَحْرُ الْبَعِيرِ يَنْحَرُهُ نَحْرًا” (*nahrul ba-eera yanharahu nahra*): he hit the spear on the spot adjacent to the chest where the throat begins. Camels are slaughtered in this way {*T*}.

Ibn Faris too says that this root has several meanings. It also means the chest as well as to split the chest open.

The Quran says:

108:2	So follow your Sustainer and do <i>wanhar</i>	فَصَلِّ لِرَبِّكَ وَانْحَرْ
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Here the writers/interpreters from past who translated the Quran have written many explanations of “وَانْحَرْ” (*wanhar*) such as:

- 1) To push the chest out while standing for prayer.
- 2) To put the right hand over the left in prayers.
- 3) To slaughter the animals of sacrifice.
- 4) To wrap both hands over the chest in prayer.
- 5) To lift the hands up to the ear when saying and starting a prayer.
- 6) To stand facing towards Mecca direction in prayer.
- 7) To kill desires
- 8) To stand facing Mecca in the morning {*T*}.

“نَحَرَ” (*nahara*): to create reach, to dominate something very well, to obtain something very well, to comprehend some matter thoroughly {*M*}.

“نَحَرْتُ الشَّيْءَ عِلْمًا” (*nahartush shay’a ilma*): I got expert about some matter through its knowledge.

“نَحَرَ الْأُمُورَ عِلْمًا” (*nahara al-amora ilma*): He got the complete knowledge of the matters.

“النَّحْرُ” (*an-nehru*) and “النَّحْرِيُّ” (*an-nehr*): expert, clever, experienced someone who comprehends everything and oversees everything and one who acts upon something very firmly {*M*}.

“وَانْحَرْ” (*wanhar*): to act firmly on something after understanding all its aspects; after dominating it in every way (108:2).

But if “وَانْحَرْ” (*wanhar*) in this verse is taken to mean the slaughter of camels, then it points to another fact.

After migration when the Messenger **Muhammed** came to Medina, the condition of the group of the Muslims was very weak and poor. The Jews were very much calling the shots there. In such conditions weak groups tend to seek the support of strong groups, and even go so far as to sacrifice their principles for this. For the Jews, camels were forbidden but allowed for the Muslims. The Jews thought that the slaughter of camels was forbidden. They thought that due to their dominance in Medina the Muslims will abstain from slaughtering of camels.

At this juncture, the Quran ordered the Muslims to go ahead and slaughter the camels, i.e. in matters of **Deen** do not compromise with the Jews. In a few days this weak group of Muslims became so strong that the Jews (who did not desist from their machinations) had to leave Medina.

Some say that in the Hebrew language, “kosher” means “allowed” and that “الْكَوْثَرُ” (*al-kausar*) in (108:1) is derived from it. Hence verse (108:1) would mean “We allowed you to slaughter camels”, but I do not subscribe to this meaning. See heading (*K-T-R*).

N-H-S

ن ح س

“النُّحَاسُ” (*an-nuhaas*), “النَّحَاسُ” (*an-nihaas*), “النَّحَاسُ” (*an-nahaas*): molten copper. It also means the sparks that fly when zinc or iron are beaten. It also means the smoke which rises and has little heat but no flame in it {*T*}.

Raghib says it means a flame which has no smoke.

“نَحْسٌ” (*nahas*): the sky has become red. The Arabs thought that this was a bad sign {*R*}.

“النَّحْسُ” (*an-nahas*): any dark matter, as well as hard labour, difficulty, loss, harm and tiredness.

“نَحَسَتْ الْإِبِلُ فُلَانًا” (*nahasatil iblu fulaana*): the camels tired the man out.

“النُّحُسُ” (*an-nuhas*): the last three nights of the month when there is no moon.

“تَنَاحَسَ فُلَانٌ” (*tanahasa fulaan*): that man turned over.

“تَنَحَّسَ الرَّجُلُ” (*tanah hasar rajul*): the man went hungry.

“نَحَسَهُ” (*nahasahu*), “نَحَسَا” (*nahsaa*): he was discourteous to him, was unfaithful to him.

Raghib says that “إَيَّامٌ نَحِسَاتٍ” (*ayyamin nahisaatin*) means “very cold days”.

Ibn Faris says it basically means the opposite of “goodness”.

“النُّحَاسُ” (*an-nuhaas*): zinc, because as compared to gold and silver, it has lesser value.

The Quran says “النُّحَاسُ” (*nuhaas*) in (55:35) to mean smoke or sparks as the punishment in *jahannam*.

Surah *Al-Qamar* says about the punishment which the nation of *Aad* faced:

54:19	the days of continuous misery	فِي يَوْمٍ نَحْسٍ مُّسْتَمِرٍّ
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“يَوْمٍ نَحْسٍ” (*yaumi nahsin*): a compound addition.

At another place it is said:

41:16	laborious days	أَيَّامٌ نَحِسَاتٍ
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These explanations show clearly that “سَعْدٌ” (*sa’ad*) and “نَحْسٌ” (*nahas*) do not hold the meanings that we generally hold them to have. For example, we say that Tuesdays are “نَحْسٌ” (*nahas*) or unlucky. This is purely a Hindu concept and based on superstition. No day or moment is either lucky or unlucky. If some misery befalls someone due to his own wrong deeds then that day becomes unlucky for him, and the day he encounters successes is good for him. As such, lucky and unlucky results are dependent upon man’s deeds and their consequences. See heading (*S-Ain-D*).

“النَّحْلُ” (*an-nahal*): honey bees {*T*} (16:86).

“النَّحْلَةُ” (*an-nihlah*), “النَّحْلَةُ” (*an-nuhlah*): the gift that is given not as some compensation or return for anything {*R*}.

Surah *An-Nisaa* says:

4:4	Give the women their <i>mehar</i> as a gift and not as a compensation	وَأْتُوا النِّسَاءَ صَدُقَاتِهِنَّ نِحْلَةً
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This means that *mehar* (the sum given by man upon wedding a woman) is given by a man to a woman (upon wedding her) without even a thought of it as a return {*T*}. The meaning of “الْعَطَاءُ بِلَا عَوَضٍ” (*al-ata'u bila iwaz*) is this as the *Lataif-ul-Lugha*, *Ibn Faris* and *Taj-ul-Uroos* say.

Raghib says that this word has been derived from “النَّحْلُ” (*nahal*), i.e. just like the bee gives us a precious gift of honey without any compensation for it, so “نِحْلَةٌ” (*nihlah*) is that precious gift which is given to the woman without thought of any compensation or return. This is the fact about *mehar*.

The Quran has not used this word, i.e. it is not a fixed sum which is mandatory as remuneration, but it is a gift which is given not as compensation but as an expression of love. Its purpose is to give the woman some weightage and importance and value her as an equal partner.

“نَحْنُ” (*nahnu*) is used to mean two masculine or feminine, and for plural first person.

“نَحْنُ رَجُلَانِ” (*nahnu rajulaan*): we are two men.

“نَحْنُ امْرَأَتَانِ” (*nahnu amra'ataan*): we are two women.

“نَحْنُ رَجَالٌ” (*nahnu rijaal*): we are all men.

“نَحْنُ نِسَاءٌ” (*nahnu niswah*): we are all women.

Surah *Al-Baghr* says:

2:14	We are joking	نَحْنُ مُسْتَهْزِئُونَ
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“نَخَرَ” (*nakhara*), “يَنْخُرُ” (*yankhur*): to sniff.

“نَخِيرٌ” (*nakheer*): the sound that is emitted from the nose.

“النَّخْرَةُ” (*an-nukhrah*): the nose itself.

“نُخْرَةُ الْأَنْفِ” (*nukhratul anf*): the front part of the nose and its end, that is, the nostril: {*T*, *F*}

“عَظْمُنَجْرٌ” (*azmun nakhir*): an old bone which is hollow inside {*T*}.

The Quran says:

79:11	old bones	عِظَامًا نَخْرَةً
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“نَخِرَتِ الشَّجَرَةُ” (*nakhiratish shajarah*): there was a sound from the hollow tree. This happens when the tree becomes moth eaten and hollow from inside and develops holes, and when the wind passes through the holes it produces a sound {*R*}.

“نَخَلَهُ” (*nakhalah*): cleaned it, liked it or selected it {*T*}.

“نَخَلَ الدَّقِيقَ” (*nakhalaḍ daqeeq*): sifted the flour through a sieve {*T*}.

“الْمُنْخَلُ” (*al-munkhal*) and “الْمُنْخُلُ” (*al-munkhul*): sieve.

“النَّخْلُ” (*an-nakhal*) or “النَّخِيلُ” (*an-nakheel*) with singular form “نَخْلَةٌ” (*nakhlah*) mean “date palms” or “coconut palms” etc. (55:68, 19:25, 2:266).

Ibn Faris says it basically means to select and like.

The date palms are called “النَّخْلُ” (*an-nakhl*) because they are among trees with the tallest trunks.

“نِدَّ” (*niddun*): like something, or similar to. But it is used for being “similar” in characteristics.

“نَدَّ البَعِيرُ” (*naddal ba-eer*): the camel balked and went wherever it wished.

“نَدَّ” (*nadd*): hatred, opposition and separation.

“نِدَّ” (*nidd*): opponent, i.e. a man who opposes you, someone who pulls you in a different direction than the one you want to follow, and the more you want to go one way the more he pulls you opposite to it.

“الْتَنَادُ” (*at-tanaadd*): to be different, to be opposite each other {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says that it means “to be different and chaotic”.

“تَنَدَّدَ” (*tandeed*): to highlight someone’s faults and to propagate them.

“لَيْسَ لَهُ نَادٌ” (*laisa lahu nadda*): he doesn’t have sustenance, i.e. he has no animal to balk {*T, M*}.

The Quran says that Allah creates means of sustenance for you:

2:22	then set up rivals to Allah	فَلَا تَجْعَلُوا لِلّٰهِ اَنْدَادًا
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This complete verse relates to the aspect of sustenance provision in this life. The Quran refers to the earth and the heavens and its produce as evidence and then relates to Allah as the creator of all the sustenance which man uses for his benefit. Then the Quran addresses man that having recognised this evidence why does man not follow the guidance revealed by Allah and associates others beside Him.

The same Surah says a little ahead:

2:165	And among the mankind there are those who take others to be equals of Allah. They desire them as they should desire Allah.	وَمِنَ النَّاسِ مَن يَتَّخِذُ مِنْ دُونِ اللّٰهِ اَنْدَادًا يُحِبُّونَهُمْ كَحُبِّ اللّٰهِ
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Here “اَنْدَادٌ” (*andadun*) means all such forces which pull one away from Allah, or the attractions which pull man away from Allah towards self, therefore any force towards which you refer due to any fear or favour and in doing this you lose affiliation with Allah, are “نِدَّ” (*nidd*) against Allah. Any concept or system which attains the place which is reserved for Allah only is a manifestation of “اندادا من دون الله” (*andadan min doonil laah*). For the meaning of “يَوْمَ التَّنَادِ” (*yaumat tanaad*) see heading (*N-D-W*).

”نَدَامَةٌ“ (*nadamah*): the regret that is over change of opinion over a matter which has now become irredeemable {*T, R*}. It also means to regret something which man has done and say if it had not been so done then it would have been better to repent, to regret {*T*}.

”نَادِمٌ“ (*naadim*) with its plural is ”نَادِمِينَ“ (*naadimeen*) means “someone who regrets or suffers” (5:31).

”النَّدِيمُ“ (*un-nadeem*): one who drinks together, a drinking companion {*T, R*}.

Surah *Yunus* says:

10:54	They will hide their regret and chagrin (or the regret will be evident)	وَأَسْرَوْا النَّدَامَةَ
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”النَّدَى“ (*un-nadaa*): dampness, dew.

”نَدَى الْأَرْضِ“ (*nada al-ard*): the dampness of the earth.

”شَجَرٌ نَدِيَانٌ“ (*shajrun nadyaan*): a tree which is fresh and green {*T, R*}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are “to gather” or “to collect” as well as “dampness”.

Since a man whose mouth is damp talks of fine things, and his voice too is high pitched.

Therefore ”النَّدَاءُ“ (*an-nidaa*) is also “to raise the voice”. It also means “sound that is high pitched and which has no words” {*T, M, R*}. Later it began to mean “talk at a get together”.

”نَادَاهُ مُنَادَاهُ“ (*nadaahu munadah*): sat with somebody in some meeting.

”النَّدَى“ (*an-nadiyyu*) and ”النَّدْوَةُ“ (*an-nadwah*): a place where a nation gets together and has mutual discussion.

”النَّدْوَةُ“ (*un-nadwah*): a group.

”دَارُ النَّدْوَةِ“ (*daarun nadwah*): a house in which the Quresh tribe used to get together.

”النَّدْوَةُ“ (*un-naadi*): tribe which was called on for help, companion.

”النَّدَى“ (*un-nadaa*): philanthropy and favour or kindness.

”الْمُنْدِيَااتُ“ (*al-mundiyaat*): demeaning work by doing which the forehead breaks out in sweat (due to shame) {*T, M, R*}.

”تَنَادَى“ (*tanaada*): to call out mutually and call each out to others. This is ”يَوْمَ التَّنَادِ“ (*yaumit tanaad*) which means “the day when everyone will be concerned about himself and will not respond to someones’s call for help, will not even heed his call for help”. The Quran has used ”نِدَاءُ“ (*nidaa’un*) to mean sound (2:171) and ”نَادَى“ (*naada*), ”يُنَادِي“ (*yunaadi*), ”نِدَاءُ“ (*nida’un*) to mean “call out” (10:52, 18:52).

The Quran says:

19:73	A very good and trusted meeting	أَحْسَنُ نَدِيًّا
29:29	Gathering	نَادِيَكُمْ
66:17	Let him call out for his companions or his tribes.	فَلْيَدْعُ نَادِيَهُ
68:21	They called out to each other	تَنَادَوْا
40:32	The day you will be running away. (the day on which you will be calling out to each other for help but nobody will come to help anyone. All will be turning and running away due to fear).	يَوْمَ تُنَادُونَ مُدِيرِينَ
40:33	On that day, there will be nobody to save you from the grip of Allah	مَا لَكُمْ مِّنَ اللَّهِ مِنْ عَاصِمٍ

“نَذَرُ” (*nazar*): something that is self-imposed in order to be safe from some loss, a pledge.
 “نَذَرُ” (*nazar*): to promise something if a certain condition is met. If someone affirms that if my child recuperates then I will do such and such thing, is also called “نَذَرُ” (*nazar*).

Raghib says it means “to impose some non-mandatory act upon you if something expected takes place”.
Ibn Faris says it means “to fear and put the fear into that which becomes mandatory”.

“نَذَرَ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*nazira bish shaiyi*): knew about something and was wary of it.
 “اِنذَارٌ” (*inzaar*): to make aware and fear the harmful effects of something beforehand.
 “نَذِيرَةُ الْجَيْشِ” (*nazeeratul jaish*): advance party, as in the army.
 “النَّذِيرُ” (*un-naazir*): someone who makes aware or warns. It also means the sound of a bow because that makes the prey aware of the danger.
 “نَذِيرٌ” (*nazeer*): old age, because it warns of imminent death {T}. As such “نَذِيرٌ” (*nazeer*) means “someone who warns against the destructive results of traversing the wrong path”, as in (76:7), (22:29). It refers to those matters which are imposed on self.

“اِنذَارٌ” (*indaaz*): to warn of destructive results, as in (36:11), but the Quran has made it clear that this “” (*inzaar*) or warning can be effective only for those who are ‘alive’ (36:70). For those who do not have the ability to be ‘alive’, it is no use warning them (2:6). “اِنذَارٌ” (*inzaar*) is only for him who self-imposes something on himself and doesn’t fulfill it. He can be told what harm will come to him if he fails to keep his pledge. But there is no use warning one of the dangers of not fulfilling a pledge if he has not pledged anything at all, or for telling a person who is bent upon suicide that to jump in the river will kill him. Only he who wants to avoid destructiveness heeds this sort of advice. Such a person is called “مُتَّقِي” (*muttaqi*).

The plural of “نَذِيرٌ” (*nazeer*) is “نُذُرٌ” (*nuzur*) as used in (54:23, 54:5).

“مُنذِرٌ” (*munzir*): someone who warns. The plural is “مُنذِرِينَ” (*munzireen*) as in (37:72, 27:92).
 “مُنذَرٌ” (*munzar*): someone who is made aware or warned. The plural is “مُنذَرِينَ” (*munzareen*) as in (37:73).

The Quran has said that messengers are “بَشِيرٌ” (*basheer*) and “مُنذِرٌ” (*nazeer*). It was their duty to tell the people, (as per the Revelation) that living as per the Quran can produce very constructive and delightful results. This is called good news or *bashaarat* and how destructive is their violation, which is called warning or *inzaar*. Those who avail of the warning are called *muttaqeen*, and by availing of the Messenger’s warning they adopted the right way. Those who were heedless of the destruction would not care about these warnings or *inzaar*.

It has been said about them:

2:6	It is the same for them if you warn them or not warn them. They will never believe.	سَوَاءٌ عَلَيْهِمْ ءَاَنذَرْتَهُمْ اَمْ لَمْ تُنذِرْهُمْ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ
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Today the duty of a *basheer* or *nazeer* is performed by the Quran as a book which is available to all those who wish to follow it. It has stated clearly through reasoning and evidence that such and such way of life has such and such result, and declared afterwards that you can adopt whichever way you want.

“نَزَعَ” (*naza*): to uproot something from its place or dig it out from its embedded place. It also means “to pull”. “اِنْتَزَعَ” (*intaza*) also means this.

“اِنْتَزَعَ” (*intaza*): “to dig out” and “to be uprooted”.

“نَزَعَ فِي الْقَوْسِ” (*naza’a fil qaus*): pulled the bow.

“اِنْتَزَعَ الشَّيْءَ” (*intazash shaiyi*): he abstained from something.

Surah *Al-Airaaf* says:

7:27	made them take off their clothes (pulled away their clothes)	يَنْزِعُ عَنْهُمَا لِبَاسَهُمَا
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It also means “someone that pulls strongly”, or “that which takes out by pulling”.

“وَالنَّازِعَاتِ غَرْقًا” (*wan-naazi-aati gharqa*): pullers (79:1).

Ibn Dureed says with reference to *Abu Abeedah* that “النَّازِعَاتُ” (*an-naaziat*) and “النَّاشِطَاتُ” (*an-naashist*) means “these are the stars which rise and shine at a place and then go away and rise and shine at another place” {T}.

Maulana Obaidullah Sindhi says that these mean “those revolutionary groups which help to pull out latent abilities within people and make the society righteous”

“نَزَعُ” (*naza’un*): to snatch. It is opposite to “إِيتَاءُ” (*eeta*) which means “to give” (3:25).

Surah *At-Toor* says about the life in heaven:

52:23	they will there exchange one with another a cup	يَتَنَازَعُونَ فِيهَا كَأْسًا
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If it is taken literally then it paints a picture of informal friendliness in which things are shared freely between people and friends. This is the condition in a heavenly society between friends.

As a further explanation of the above this verse would mean “they (the people in the group of the *momineen*) will take the cup of life from each other”. Heavenly life is not individualistic in which every man is for him only. There everyone shares with others (the good things) which nurture and furthers their self-development. The Quran directs to avoid the sort of conflict in which one wants to keep everything for himself (8:46). In a heavenly society all this “give and take” would be done willingly through an inner desire and to promote each other. But in a wrongful society the intent of every man would be to snatch from others and keep everything for him.

“النَّزَائِعُ” (*an-naaza’u*): the winds which blow but away from their rightful path, and keep striking or hitting against one another {T}. This makes clear what conflict is and there is no conflict in an Islamic society, rather mutual harmony and an atmosphere of “أَلْفَ بَيْنٍ قُلُوبِكُمْ” (*allafa baina qulubikum*) (3:102) i.e. camaraderie.

“نَزَعَ” (*nazah*): to pinch, prick or push into or to criticize {*M*}. Therefrom it came to mean “to enter into something in order to spoil it” or “sabotage” {*M*}.

“نَزَعَ بَيْنَهُمْ نَزْعًا” (*nazagha bainahum nazgha*): created disharmony or chaos among them {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says the above stated are its basic meanings.

The Quran says:

12:100	After that the shaitaan (or the feeling of envy) created disharmony among me and my brothers.	مِنْ بَعْدِ أَنْ نَزَعَ الشَّيْطَانُ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَ إِخْوَتِي
7:200	When (the feeling of self-interest) creates a thing which may create chaos, or make one oppose the other	وَإِنَّمَا يَنْزِعُكَ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ نَزْعٌ

“الْمِنْزَغَةُ” (*al-minzagha*): the long rod with which the cook pierces the bread during cooking {*T*}, and brings the bread out of a tandoor (oven) by hanging it on the rod.

Ibn Faris says “نَزَفَ” (*nazf*) means for something to be “cut off” or be “terminated”.

“نَزَفَ مَاءَ الْبَيْرِ” (*nazafa maa'al bi'r*): he pulled all the water out of the well.

“نَزَفَتِ الْبَيْرُ” (*nazafatil bi'r*): the well became empty of all water.

“نَزَفَ فُلَانٌ” (*nuzifa fulaan*): that man became devoid of intellect, he became drunk and unconscious.

“أَنْزَفَ الرَّجُلُ” (*anzafar rajul*): the man became drunk and lost consciousness. The spring of his intellect became dry.

“الْمِنْزَفَةُ” (*al-minzafah*): the small bucket which is tied at the end of a stick and then this stick is tied to another stick which is embedded in the ground for pulling out water from a well {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

37:47	They will not get drunk from the wine of the <i>jannat</i> (it will be so pure and will produce no stupor)	وَلَا هُمْ عَنْهَا يُنْزِفُونَ
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“سَكْرَانٌ نَزِيفٌ” (*sakraanu nazeef*): the drunken man who has lost his intellect due to drunkenness {*R*}.

Note that Surah *As-Sa'afaat* says:

56:19	Cups of wine in <i>jannat</i> will never go dry there will be no decrease in the taste of that wine	وَلَا يَنْزِفُونَ
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“نَزَلَ” (*nazal*): to descend from a height.

The Quran says “نُزُولٌ” (*nuzool*) as against “عُرُوجٌ” (*urooj*) which means “ascent” (34:3).

“نُزُلٌ” (*nuzul*): destination. It also means the things with which a host is shown hospitality. It also means expansion and gift (18:102, 3:197). It also means “the growth of the crop”.

“أَرْضٌ نَزْلَةٌ” (*arzun nazalah*): land which gets much used for cultivation and where a lot of crops grow.

“النَّزْلُ” (*an-nazalu*): rain.

“نَزْلَةٌ” (*nazlah*): a one-time descent (53:3).

“نَزِيلٌ” (*nazeel*): guest (26:192).

“مَنْزِلٌ” (*manzil*): the place to descend. The plural is “مَنَازِلٌ” (*manazil*).

The main difference between “نَزَلَ” (*anzila*) and “نُزِلَ” (*nuzila*) is that the later one is used to mean “descend gradually and steadily”, while *anzila* does not have this condition of slow descend {*Lataif-ul-Lugha*}.

29:63	The rainwater descend gradually from the sky (it does not all descend at once)	نَزَلَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءٌ
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Ibn Faris says that “النَّزِيلُ” (*un-nazaeel*) means “to put” or “arrange” something in its proper place.

In the Quran it has come to mean not only “descent” but also “to give”.

“وَ أَنْزَلْنَا الْحَدِيدَ” (*wa anzaln al hadeed*): We gave iron (57:25). It has also come to mean “several things to be discovered”.

Surah *Al-Hijr* says that:

15:21	We have treasures of different things with us but We let them be discovered according to a measure	وَمَا نُنَزِّلُهُ إِلَّا بِقَدَرٍ مَعْلُومٍ
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Obviously the things which are not present in the universe, to reveal or make them descend would mean that man should discover them with his efforts and quest. Therefore “إِنْزَالٌ” (*inzaal*) at such places would mean “to provide man with the means whereby he can obtain these things”. The treasure troves of these things are present in the universe and man only has to discover them. Their attainment depends on man’s efforts to obtain them.

The Quran has mentioned the word “تَنْزِيلٌ” (*tanzeel*) and it is meant “to convey that the Revelation” which has been revealed to the Messenger is not a figment of his imagination, i.e. it is not a subjective thing but an objective thing. Therefore Revelation cannot be obtained with one’s effort. This can only be granted by Allah. In the material world, man reveals things by discovering them with his own effort, but in Revelation the truth reveals itself to the Messenger. Therefore the word “إِنْزَالٌ” (*inzaal*) has been used for it, i.e. man himself does not rise to the truth and unveils it but the truth itself descends and reveals itself to him. This is a particular characteristic of the Revelation. But since the process of Revelation has ended with the Messenger *Muhaammed*, therefore this knowledge can now only be obtained by man in two ways. One is by the truths as contained in the Quran, and the other is to discover truths in the physical world. There is no third source of knowledge. The claim of meditation is actually a claim to achieve Revelation in different words. There is no mention of meditation in the Quran. Therefore any such claim is against the Quran. There are some forces in man (like the power of intent or thought) that if developed can develop characteristics that are not normal in a person. People tend to think that they are the manifestations of meditation and consider them to be spiritual gifts. Although spiritualism has no connection with this, nor has *Deen* any connection with it, because any man of any religion can become capable of this with a little practice. Even non-believers and atheists can do this, but the purpose of *Deen* is to turn out righteous human beings, not to create such “magic”.

“مُنْزِلٌ” (*munazzil*): one who makes something descends from a height, someone who reveals someone, who bestows (4:115).

“مُنْزِلٌ” (*munzil*): that which has been descended or revealed (29:34; 6:115).

“مُنْزَلٌ” (*munzal*): that which has been revealed (3:123). It is also used to mean place and time.

23:29	O my Sustainer, descend unto me that which is full of <i>barkat</i>	رَبِّ أَنْزِلْنِي مُنْزَلًا مُبَارَكًا
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Surah *Yusuf* says “” (*munzil*) i.e. hospitable:

12:59	and I am very hospitable	وَ أَنَا خَيْرُ الْمُنْزِلِينَ
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“تَنْزُلٌ” (*tanazzul*): to descend slowly. “تَنْزَالٌ” (*tanazzal*) has been derived from it (97:4).

- “نَسَا” (*nas'un*): to scold, to drive, to move back.
 “نَسَا الشَّيْءَ” (*nasaash shaiyi*): to move something back.
 “أَنَسَاهُ” (*ansa'ah*): moved him away.
 “نَسَاْتُ الْبَيْعَ” (*nasaatuhul bai*): in trade I dealt in credit and thus deferred the payment.
 “الْأَنْسَاءُ” (*attansi'ah*): to delay a deal in which the payment or the thing is delivered later than planned.
 “بَاعَهُ بِنَسِيْنَةٍ” (*ba'ahu binasiynah*): Made a deal with him on credit.
 “الْمِنْسَاءُ” (*al-minsa'ah*): stick with which animals are driven back (33:14).

Ibn Faris too subscribes to all these meanings.

Surah *Tawbah* says:

9:37	Surely forgetting is an addition of denial.	إِنَّمَا النَّسِيءُ زِيَادَةٌ فِي الْكُفْرِ
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“النَّسِيءُ” (*an-nisyo*): a special thing in Arab society. The Quran has explained it by saying:

9:37	One year they declare it as <i>haraam</i> and the other year they declare it as <i>halaal</i>	يُحْلِلُونَ غَاِمًا وَ يُحَرِّمُونَ غَاِمًا
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But it is necessary to understand the details of this above verse. The lunar month was observed among the Arabs. *Rabih*, *Jamaadi*, *Ramadan* etc. are the months that are said to be linked to the seasons, but the same month could occur in the same season only if the month is solar not lunar. In case the months are lunar, the same months occur during different seasons. The Arabs did not like this and wanted that the month of *Hajj* should occur during the same season every year. For this they used to skip a month every three years (following the Jews) to adjust the months according to the seasons.

This month that they used to leave out was usually after the month of *Zilhajja*. This moving of the month forward and backwards was called “نَسِيءٌ” (*nasii*), i.e. to bring the year back by one month.

Also four months during the year (i.e. *Rajab*, *Zi Qadah*, *Zul Hajja* and *Muharram*) were sacred for them in which murder and robbery etc. were forbidden. To adjust the calendar was the duty of the group of *Banu Kanana* which was called “نَسَاءُ” (*nas'ah*). This “نَسَاءُ” (*nasa'ah*) sometimes changed these sacred months like saying instead of the month of *Moharram* this year the month of *Rabi'al Awwal* will be the sacred month. Sometimes they moved the month of the third year back or forth. This created chaos in affairs of the society and those who had fore knowledge of this change would profit from it. This too was called “نَسِيءٌ” (*nasii*).

The Quran put an end to both these kinds of “نَسِيءٌ” (*nasii*). On one hand it announced:

9:26	According to the laws of Allah, there are twelve months in an year. And to leave a month every third year is a meaningless thing	إِنَّ عِدَّةَ الشُّهُورِ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ اثْنَا عَشَرَ شَهْرًا
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After this announcement (in 10 A.D.) the Arabic calendar began to have 12 months, although this remained lunar. This meant that although these were named as before these do not fall in the seasons as before, such as *Ramadan*, which means “hot summer”, but now it also occurs in winter.

If the solar year is followed, this month falls every year in the same season, and twelve months of the year are completed even so, i.e. the period in which the earth completes its revolution around the sun is divided into 12 months. But the Quran does not limit one to follow the lunar or solar calendar (17:12, 10:5, 6:97).

The Quran ended both kinds of “نَسِيءٌ” (*nasii*), and has called the extending of the year as “زِيَادَةُ الْفِيلِ الْكُفْرِ” (*ziyadatun fil kufri*) in (9:37). Thus society was established on a sound basis.

The Quran's principle is workable still now, that during the month of *Moharram*, war must be ceased in any part of the world. There are many benefits of thus delaying or temporary stoppage to war. In many

cases the ceasefire may lead to the end of a war. All nations are expected to cease fire during this period because then it will be akin to “نَسِيءٌ” (*nasii*) which the Quran has declared to be denial or the refutation of practical instructions.

N-S-B

ن س ب

“النَّسَبُ” (*an-nasab*), “النَّسْبَةُ” (*an-nisbah*): relationship, especially among the forefathers. It also means the similarity between two things.

“النَّسْبَةُ” (*an-naisab*): ants, when they are travelling in a line, i.e. behind each other, hence it also means “the path of the ants” {*T, R*}.

“نَسَبٌ” (*an-nasab*): family relationship.

Ibn Faris says it means a relationship of one thing to another.

The Quran has used “نَسَبًا” (*nasaba*) to mean “relation” in (25:54). The plural is “أَنْسَابٌ” (*ansaab*) as in (23:101).

N-S-Kh

ن س خ

“نَسَخَ” (*naskh*): cancel or delete or remove a thing and replace it with another, to replace something {*Ibn Faris*}.

“نَسَخَتِ الشَّمْسُ الظِّلَّ” (*nasakhatish shamsaz zilla*): the sun removed the shade and brought light in place. Hence it also means “to change into something”.

“نَسَخَتِ الرِّيحُ أَثَارَ الدِّيَارِ” (*nasakhatir reehu aasaarad dyar*): the wind changed the signs of habitation, i.e. the ancient remains or ruins were covered with sand and thus were obscured.

“نَسَخَ الْكِتَابَ” (*nasakhal kitaab*): to copy a book and create a similar book.

“النُّسْخَةُ” (*an-nuskha*): a copied book {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

45:29	We used to have it written	إِنَّا كُنَّا نَنسَخُ
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This word has been used to mean “wipe out” and “remove”:

22:52	God obliterates	فَيَنْسَخُ اللَّهُ
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As such “نَسَخَ” (*naskh*) means “to replace one thing with another”. This word is important because this word has a special place in our *Deen*. A wrong meaning uproots the *Deen* and the right meaning establishes the *Deen*.

The general belief is that there are about 500 verses in the Quran which are obsolete, although these are still read (& recited). This means that these are only read for ‘reward’ but have no practical meaning anymore since the orders contained in them are obsolete. Some of the orders have been cancelled by other verses and some have been cancelled by the *hadith*. At the same time there is a belief that some verses are not contained in the Quran but their orders are there, such as that of *rajam* or to stone adulterers, etc.

The following verse is translated as commonly reported:

2:106	We replace the verses we cancel or make forget. Do you not know that Allah is dominant over all things and can do anything?	مَا نَنْسَخْ مِنْ آيَةٍ أَوْ نُنسِهَا نَأْتِ بِخَيْرٍ مِنْهَا أَوْ مِثْلَهَا - أَلَمْ تَعْلَمْ أَنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ
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This is a traditional translation based on the interpretations written during the dictatorships from the past.

This essentially means that Allah ordered something and after some time he thought that this order should be cancelled. Hence he revealed another verse which cancelled the former verse. This order was better than the former order. Note that the new verse never contained the information as to which verse was to be cancelled. That is why the so-called cancelled verses are also present in the Quran. This distinction as to which verse is cancelled by which verse has been made by the traditional writers of the Quran either through tradition or by their own thoughts, but not the Quran. Therefore there is always a difference in the number of such verses.

As far as forgetting the verses is concerned, it is believed that Allah revealed the verses but the Messenger **Muhammed** used to forget some of them, so they were replaced by similar verses. This is what “أَوْ تُنْسِيَهَا” (*au nunsuha*) is taken to mean.

The verse that is presented in support of this is:

87:6	We will teach you to read, and you shall not forget except that which Allah wants	سَنُقَرِّئُكَ فَلَا تَنْسَى إِلَّا مَا شَاءَ اللَّهُ
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Note that these concepts create negative impressions (& create doubts) about the Quran, Allah, and His Messenger.

- About Allah the concept is that He issues some order but then reviews it because the former order was weak. He cancels the order to issue another in its place.
- About the Quran it is thought that many verses are obsolete but despite this the verses are still recited, and it is nowhere shown which verses are cancelled. It has been left to the people to decide this.
- About the Messenger **Muhammed** it is thought that he used to forget some verses revealed by Allah!

All of this is false as the Quran is a complete book and nothing is cancelled.

The right meaning of “ناسخ” (*naasikh*) and “منسوخ” (*munsookh*), i.e. “cancelled and in force”, will be mentioned ahead. For the right meaning see heading (*N-S-Y*), where it has been fully explained.

Now we will analyse the correct interpretation of this verse. The **Ahl-e-Kitaab** (those with the Book) especially the Jews used to raise many objections to the Messenger **Muhammed**. The Quran answers these objections. One of their important objections was that when God has revealed His orders through other Messengers (such as **Moosa**), what was the need for this new messenger and this new Book. They were told that it is right that God is guiding man since **Nooh** but a part of these orders given in the earlier books have been period specific or pertaining to a certain period only, and they were relevant in the context of the nation to which they were sent. They were to be implemented during the period that they were sent in. Later, when that nation ceased to exist or the situation had changed, then another messenger used to replace him and he used to bring another set of orders based on the same permanent values. Thus the new Revelation used to replace the former Revelation. They themselves were witnesses to this kind of change of many orders of the **Torah** which, **Isa** had changed.

Secondly, human intellect and reasoning is evolving as the time progresses and the revelation from God is according to the evolutionary stage attained by people of a generation. Orders higher than their intellectual level were held back until another nation replaced that nation which would be certainly higher in the evolutionary and intellectual level. Those orders or laws which had been ‘held back’ earlier were then revealed. This principle has been operative in the disclosure of the Revelation throughout.

It has also been seen that after a messenger passes away, his nation gave up certain sections of his teachings or ignored some part of the Revelation. Therefore these ignored parts (which did not need any amendment) were reinvigorated through the Revelation of the messenger that came later. In the period prior to the Quran it was difficult to preserve the contents of the revelation and this led to changes in the text through human hands.

The Jews were told that this had been the practice with the Revelation. Now the time had come when human consciousness and mind would attain higher level of maturity. As such it had now been so

arranged that all such orders that were given to the earlier messengers in accordance with their times, and which were particular to their nation were cancelled, and current laws were sent. Since the system of Revelation was coming to an end (with the Quran), and the laws were to stay unchanged for man till the end, therefore these orders and laws were definitely better than the earlier orders. We should note here that the permanent values noted in the Quran never changed; these remained the same from the appearance of the first man to the last man leaving this world e.g. equality as a human being, accountability, justice, warning, etc.

The laws that were held back because human intellect had not reached the stage where it could understand them or implement them properly, were now too revealed or implemented because the Quran would match man's highest intellectual level till the end of the world.

All such laws that had been ignored by nations of the former messengers or given up or which had been modified/changed were renewed i.e. that orders like them were given.

This is the need for which a new messenger (the Messenger **Muhammed**) and a new Book was sent, and this is the reason why belief in all previous books should be replaced by a belief in the Quran and which must be followed.

Now there is no other guidance except the Quran:

2:137	If they believe (as you) then these people will be able to receive guidance, but if they avoid this path then they will be going opposite to Allah's guidance	فَإِنْ آمَنُوا بِمِثْلِ مَا آمَنْتُمْ بِهِ فَقَدْ اهْتَدَوْا وَإِنْ تَوَلَّوْا فَإِنَّمَا هُمْ فِي شِقَاقٍ
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This is the right meaning of these verses. Now we will see how the literal meanings reflect the figurative meanings.

We have seen what “نَسَخَ” (*nasakh*) means, i.e. “to replace something”. When the Quran says “verse” it does not only mean the verse of the Quran. Every messenger's Revelation has been called the verses of Allah. For example, in the story of Adam, in Surah *Al-Baqrah* it is said that Adam was told:

2:38	whenever guidance (or instructions) from Me are received and whoever follows those instructions will have no fear or grief	فَأَمَّا يَا نَبِيَّكُمْ مِّنِّي هُدًى فَمَنِ تَبِعَ هُدَايَ فَلَا خَوْفٌ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا هُمْ يَحْزَنُونَ
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This shows that wherever instructions have been received from Allah, they have been termed as verses of Allah-.

Verses or instructions do not only mean the instructions given in the Quran, but the change of or replacement of the verses of a former Revelation by the verses of a later Revelation, as it is mentioned in Surah *Al-Nahal*:

16:101	And when we replace one verse by another.	وَ إِذَا بَدَّلْنَا آيَةً مَكَانَ آيَةٍ
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“نُنْسِيهَا” (*nunsiha*) has been derived from the word “نَسَى” (*nasi'a*) which means “to give something up”, or “to ignore it”. See heading (*N-Y-S*). This word encompasses the fact that former revealed books were not allowed to stay in their original state. As such, the Quran says that after every messenger passed away, rebellious people added something to their books themselves, but Allah kept replacing these adulterated verses or which were given up by those people, through a new Book and a new messenger (22:52). This too clarifies that new verse in place of a former verse means instructions of the former Revelation were replaced, not that one instruction of this Quran is replaced by a new instruction within it.

“نَسَى” (*nasi'a*) also means to leave something as it is in its former state. Thus “نُنْسِيهَا” (*nunsiha*) of verses would mean that the verses We thought should not be changed were incorporated by Us in the new Revelation as they were before.

Thus the Quran is in this way the “مُهِينٌ” (*muhai’un*) of all Revelations of former messengers (5:28), i.e. all those laws have been embodied in the Quran, and on the other hand, it completes all the laws that were necessary for mankind:

6:116	Neither is there need for any change or amendment in it by Allah nor can any man change it	وَمَثَّ كَلِمَتَ رَبِّكَ صِدْقًا وَعَدْلًا لَا مُبَدِّلَ لِكَلِمَتِهِ
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Allah Himself has taken upon Himself to keep it intact and safe (15:9).

The question that arises was why did Allah keep the system of Revelation as such? The reply that was given is:

2:106	Allah knows in what proportion (way) things are required (to be done)	إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ
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Therefore He knows when man needs what kind of instructions and when he should receive complete code of conduct. All this occurs according to His estimates upon which he has full grasp. This is the right meaning of *naasikh* and *munsookh*. As far as the Quran is concerned, not one word in it is *munsookh* or cancelled. Every instruction contained in it is unchangeable and un-cancelled, although every order is imposed according to particular circumstances. When a situation changes, the orders change as well. For instance, there is the order for ablution, but if water is not available or a man is sick, then he can perform “تيمم” (*tayamom*) in place of “وضو” (*wuzoo*) as said in (5:6). When water is available or the sickness is cured, then the order for ablution will be restored and the order for “تيمم” (*tayamom*) will recede into the background.

Or for example, the Quran has fixed a punishment for a thief and a rapist etc. Obviously if in a society these crimes take place then the Quran’s orders (about the punishments for these crimes) will not be implemented. Or if a society does not contain poor people, or beggars then the relevant orders will not need to be implemented, or if a man does not leave any inheritance then the laws about inheritance will not need to be implemented. Obviously these affairs do not have anything to do with *naasikh* or *munsookh*, but these orders remain in place (lest the situation arises where they need to be implemented). *Munsookh* or cancellation means to be cancelled for ever and never to be implemented. There is no such order in the Quran.

If in (2:106) the verse with “مَانَسَخَ” (*manansakh*) or the verse (16:101) in Surah *Al-Nahal*, the word “آيَةٍ” (*aayah*) is taken to mean universal events (which the Quran calls the signs of Allah at many places), then “نسخ آيت” (*naskh aayaats*) or cancelled verses would mean for one universal event to replace another. Scientists are well aware of this phenomenon, but we think that the former meaning is preferable, although the second meaning does broaden the scope of the meaning.

But no matter which meaning among the two is taken, the fact remains that no verse of the Quran stands cancelled. Every word of this unchangeable book is stolid in its place and will remain so.

N-S-R

ن س ر

“النَّسْرُ” (*an-nasr*): vulture, but the Arabs have different names for different kinds of vultures. A vulture has sharp eyes and can fly over long distances. Researchers say “نَسْرٌ” (*nasarun*) was also the name of an idol of the tribe *zil kulaah* in the land of *hammeer* {T}. The Quran has mentioned this word in the context of the nation of *Nooh* (7:23).

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this word is “to grab” or “snatch”, and that “النَّسْرُ” (*an-nasr*) means vulture. The Quran has however used it to mean the idol of the nation of *Nooh*.

- “نَسَفَ الْبِنَاءَ يُنْسِفُهُ” (*nasafal bina’a yansifhu*): he uprooted the building.
 “الْمُنْسَفَةُ” (*al-minsafah*): the implement with which a building is uprooted.
 “نَسَفَ الطَّعَامَ” (*nasafat tu’aam*): he thrashed the crop.
 “الْمُنْسَفُ” (*al-insaf*): foam.
 “نَسَفَتِ الرِّيحُ الشَّيْءَ” (*nasafatir reehush shaiya*): the wind blew a thing away, uprooted it and scattered it.
 “نَسَفَ الْبَعِيرُ الْأَرْضَ بِمُقَدِّمِ رِجْلِهِ” (*nasafal ba-eeru arda bi muqaddimi rijlihi*): camel raised dust with its front foot {T}.
 “النَّسَافَةُ” (*an-nusafah*): that which flies off by thrashing.
 “الْمُنْسَفَةُ” (*al-minsafah*): sieve.
 “نَسَفَ الشَّيْءَ” (*nasafa shaiyi*): to pass something through the sieve.
 “النَّسِيفُ” (*an-naseef*): the mark which is produced by spurring the camel on.

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings are “كَشَفَ” (*kashf*) or “to open and make obvious”.

Surah *Taaha* says:

20:97	We will let it flow in the river (dismember its elements and throw them in the river)	لَنَنْسِفَنَّ فِي الْيَمِّ نَسْفًا
20:105	your <i>Rab</i> (Sustainer) will uproot them	يَنْسِفُهَا رَبِّي نَسْفًا

- “نَسَكَ الثَّوْبَ” (*nasakas saub*): he washed the cloth and thus cleaned it.
 “أَرْضٌ نَاسِكَةٌ” (*ardun naasika*): green land on which it has rained recently {R}.

Muheet says the real meaning of this word is “to wash and make clean”. All other meanings are related to this meaning. This basic meaning leads to its meaning “to right” or “correct some matter”.

- “نَسَكَ السَّبَخَةَ” (*nasakas sabakha*): he corrected the salinity of the soil.
 “نَسَكَ إِلَى طَرِيقَةٍ جَمِيلَةٍ” (*asaka ila tariqatin jameelah*): he adopted a better way and stuck to it {R}.

In Arabic, “مَنْسَكٌ” (*mansak*) is any place to and from which people are habitual or are familiar with, whether the path leads to evil or good. Later “مَنْاسِكٌ” (*manasik*) came to mean the customs of the *Hajj* (pilgrimage) and “نُسُكٌ” (*nusk*) or “نَسِيكَةٌ” (*naseekah*) meant the animal which is slaughtered or the blood {R}. Thereafter it came to mean anything that has been made mandatory by Allah. Thus “مَنْاسِكٌ” (*manasik*) came to mean the obligations towards Allah {M}.

Ibn Qateebah says it means anything which takes man closer to Allah.

Shah Abdul Qadir, *Shah Rafiudin* and *Maulana Abulm Kalam Azad* in their translations have translated “” (*manasik*) as “worship” or “the elements of Hajj”. The latter has translated “نُسُكٌ” (*nusuk*) as “my Hajj”.

The Quran has said in the context of orders related to Hajj:

2:200	When you are free of (performing) the obligations of hajj	فَإِذَا قَضَيْتُمْ مَنَاسِكَكُمْ
2:162	its compensation will be fasting, or <i>sadaqah</i> or animals for slaughter	فَعِدَّةٌ مِنْ صِيَامٍ أَوْ صَدَقَةٍ أَوْ نُسُكٍ

Ibn Qateebah has said that here “نُسُكٌ” (*nusuk*) would mean the animals for slaughter {R}.

Ibn Faris too says that it means “animals for slaughter” and “to attain closeness to someone”, but its meaning should not be restricted to the “animals for slaughter”. It can mean any good deed that one may pledge to do.

Surah **Al-Anaam** says:

6:163	Tell them that my salat and my nusuk (my life and my death) are all dedicated to establish/follow the system of Allah	قُلْ إِنَّ صَلَاتِي وَنُسُكِي وَمَحْيَايَ وَمَمَاتِي لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ
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Obviously here “صلوة” (**salaat**) has come to mean “the complete code of life (i.e. Deen) according to the Quran” and “نُسُكٌ” (**nusuk**) means “every practice in life” {**M**}.

Surah **Al-Hajj** contains a comprehensive verse:

22:67	We had formulated a path for every nation which believed in the messenger of their time and which way it was supposed to follow. Therefore these people should not quarrel regarding its commands. As such, keep on inviting them to the ways of your Sustainer	لِكُلِّ أُمَّةٍ جَعَلْنَا مَنْسَكًا هُمْ نَاسِكُوهُ فَلَا يُنَازِعُونَكَ فِي الْأَمْرِ فَادْعُ إِلَى رَبِّكَ
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This shows that “امر” (**amr**) is an unchangeable law which has always remained unchanged, and “مَنَاسِكٌ” (**manasik**) the peripheries or the customs and practices of this system that are adopted to meet the needs of the times in establishing the system. “مَنَاسِكٌ” (**manasik**) have been varying but “امر” (**amr**) cannot differ or be controversial. The invitation that Islam held out was basically towards this unchangeable “امر” (**amr**) but people instead of adopting this, considered the fundamentals of **Deen** to lie in the peripheries or the “مَنَاسِكٌ” (**manasik**) – the evidence for this is all around us and we can relate to it by seeing that these religious practices which do not solve the human problems as the Quran has directed. This is the truth that is not found anywhere except in the Quran – the Quran since deals with the human thought process, therefore it directs our mind to the true reality behind all human issues i.e. makes us see through any human issue. As it takes time to get our thinking in line with the Quranic thinking, the Quran tells us unambiguously that do not doubt this guidance because you are:

22:67	Indeed your are on the straight guided path	إِنَّكَ لَعَلَىٰ هُدًى مُسْتَقِيمٍ
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But it is obvious that if one agrees with this then he will also have to act on the details as proscribed by the **Deen** as an Islamic System. We have to take the Quran as a whole and accept it as a complete book of guidance which provides details of the permanent values which are applicable for all times. While the permanent values remain unchanged the ‘**manasik**’ can vary and can be modified through mutual consultation as these relate to the collective physical conduct to carry out the issues of the daily life. This is a must to establish the system otherwise it will be disrupted {**R**}.

By this count it must be understood that if “مَنَاسِكٌ” (**manasik**) can change during different era then they can also change in different lands according to the different circumstances if they have not been fixed or made mandatory by the Quran. But if the circumstances so demand, this change will be brought about by the system of the Quran and not by individuals.

“النَّسْلُ” (*un-nasl*): for something to separate.

“نَسَلَ الْوَبَرُ عَنِ الْبَعِيرِ” (*nasala wabar unil ba-eer*): the camel’s hair fell off and separated from the camel.

“نَسَلَ الْقَمِيصُ عَنِ الْإِنْسَانِ” (*nasalat gameesu unil insaan*): the shirt parted from the man {*R*}.

“النُّسَالَةُ” (*un-nusaalah*): the wool that falls off, or for a bird’s feathers to fall off {*M*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “for something to easily get out and take out”.

“نَسَلَ” (*nasala*), “يَنْسِلُ” (*yansil*): speeded up, ran.

“أَنْسَلَ الْقَوْمُ” (*andalal qaum*): he went ahead of the nation.

“زَيْبٌ نَسُولٌ” (*zi’bun nasul*): a fast wolf {*M, R*}.

“النَّسَالُ” (*an-nas-saal*): speedy.

“النَّسْلُ” (*an-nasal*): milk that drops at its own from teats {*R, M*}.

The progeny is called “نَسْلٌ” (*nasal*) because it comes out of its forefathers, or because the forefathers die and it lives on or proceeds ahead.

The Quran says:

2:205	Destroy land and animal life	يُهْلِكُ الْخَرْثَ وَالنَّسْلَ
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“نَسْلٌ” (*nasl*): creation, progeny and human population. As such, it means “to destroy human generation or crops (without being justified) is forbidden”.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says:

21:66	They will come out fast like the waves in a storm	وَهُمْ مِنْ كُلِّ حَدَبٍ يَنْسِلُونَ
36:51	Will come out fast and rush towards their Sustainer	إِلَىٰ رَبِّهِمْ يَنْسِلُونَ

“النِّسْوَةُ” (*an’niswatu*), “النِّسَاءُ” (*an’nisao*), “النِّسْوَانُ” (*an’niswanu*) are all plurals of the word “الْمَرْأَةُ” (*al-mar’atu*) which means “one woman” and “النِّسَاءُ” (*an’nisaa’a*) which means “more than one woman”.

This word only exists in plural form as “النِّسَاءُ” (*an-nisa’a*), “النِّسْوَةُ” (*an-niswah*) and “النِّسْوَانُ” (*an-naswan*), and their used singular form does not come from the same literal root.

The Quran has used the term “نِسَاءٌ” (*nisa’a*) to mean “common women” as well as “wives”.

2:187	your wives	إِلَىٰ نِسَائِكُمْ
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Figuratively this word has been used for the group of people who are devoid of manliness. For details see Heading (*Dh-B-H*) and (*B-N-W*).

“نَسِيَانٌ” (*nisiyaan*): leave or give up. It is also used for a person who forgets about protecting something which is kept with him for safety, i.e. “to leave protecting or stop protecting something”.

20:115	and verily We had ordered Adam first but he gave it up and We found no determination in him	وَلَقَدْ عَهِدْنَا إِلَىٰ آدَمَ مِنْ قَبْلِ فَتَسِيٍّ وَلَمْ يَجِدْ لَهُ عَزْماً
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Here *nasi* (نَسِيٍّ) means “to give up” because accountability cannot take place upon forgetting something, plus there is no need for intent and determination in remembering something – it just becomes part of our memory system.

9:67	They ignored the guidance of Allah so as a consequence Allah gave up their protecting them	نَسُوا اللَّهَ فَنَسِيَهُمْ
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We generally say that “we advised you several times (about something) but you forgot them”. Here forgot them does not mean that they got lost from your memory, rather that “you did not act upon those advices” or “you acted upon them for some time but later stopped doing so”. It also means “to let something remain as it is”. In support of this, the author of *Gharib-ul-Quran* by *Mirza Abul Fazl* has related the statement of *Ibn Abbas*.

Surah *Al-Baqrevelation* to earlier messengers:

2:106	if We cancel a former command then We replace it with a better command and that which We leave as it is then We give a similar command through the Revelation to the next messenger	مَا نَنْسَخْ مِنْ آيَةٍ أَوْ نُنسِهَا نَأْتِ بِخَيْرٍ مِنْهَا أَوْ مِثْلَهَا
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See details under heading (*N-S-Kh*). Likewise verse (87:7) means that “in this way We shall preserve the revelation so you will not be able to give up anything”. Hence nothing shall escape from it and everything shall be compiled in one place. Its safety is ensured and referred at another place:

17:86	If We want We can take away something from the Revelation (but Our Will is not such)	وَلَقَدْ شِئْنَا لَنَذْهَبَنَّهُ بِالَّذِي أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْكَ
87:7	only if the Will of Allah was like this, then anything could be taken away (but this is not the Will of Allah)	إِلَّا مَا شَاءَ اللَّهُ

Therefore nothing in it has been forsaken (17:86), also see (5:101) {*T*}.

The author of the book *Al-minaar* has said that even if this is taken to mean “to forget something” then the phrase “إِلَّا مَا شَاءَ اللَّهُ” (*illa masha'allah*) nullifies it. This means that as has been said before, it will never happen – the proof of this lies in the reading, understanding and analysing the Quranic guidance in relation to the human issues and their solutions.

At another place it is said:

11:108	they will dwell therein, for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure, except as your Lord wills; a gift without break.	خَالِدِينَ فِيهَا مَا دَامَتِ السَّمُوتُ وَالْأَرْضُ إِلَّا مَا شَاءَ رَبُّكَ عَطَاءٌ غَيْرُ مَجْذُودٍ
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To give up protecting something means that the thing was thought unworthy of protection, or that it was thought without importance. Therefore “النَسْيُ” (*an-nasi'o*) means something which is not thought important and thus given up. Its plural is “النَسَاءُ” (*an-nasao*). Therefore at the time of departure of a caravan, the Arabs used to say “تَتَبِعُوا أَنْسَاءَكُمْ” (*tatabassa'oo ansa'aakum*) which means “collect your small things which you generally think unimportant” {*T*}. On account of this non-importance, the word acquired the meaning of “forgetfulness”.

“أَنْسَاؤُهُ” (*ansa’oo iyyahu*): he forgot him.
 “نَسَاؤٌ” (*nasaoon*): one who is very forgetful {T}.
 “نَسِيًا مَّنْسِيًّا” (*nasyan mansiyyan*): long forgotten (19:23).

N-Sh-A

ن ش ا

“نَشَأَ” (*nasha*), “يَنْشَأُ” (*yansha’o*), “نَشَأَتْ” (*nash’atan*): to be alive, to be new, to be manifested, to be highlighted, to be lofty, to increase, and to develop gradually, to grow.
 “نَشَأَتِ السَّحَابُ نَشَأً” (*nasha’atis sahabtun nasha*): the cloud rose.
 “النَّاشِءُ” (*an’naashi*): a boy or girl who is leaving childhood and entering adulthood, or is near that stage.
 “النَّاشِءَةُ” (*an’naashi’atu*): every moment in which a man keeps standing i.e. does not sleep. This also means “to rise after sleeping” and “every event that happens at night”.
 “تَنْشَأُ فُلَانٌ لِحَاجَتِهِ” (*tanasha fulanun lihaajatih*): so and so man rose for his work and left.
 “الْمُنْشَأُ” (*al-munsha’o*): high sign or flag.
 “الْجَوَارِ الْمُنْشَأُتْ” (*al-jawaril munsha’aat*): boats with high sails (55:24).
 “الْإِنْشَاءُ” (*al-insha’o*): to invent something and to train it {R}.
 “النَّشْءُ” (*an’nash’o*): descent {M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to be lofty.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:99	Allah has created you from a single <i>nafas</i> (cell)	هُوَ الَّذِي أَنْشَأَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ
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The details can be found in the book titled *Iblees O Adam*.

Surah *Al-Waqiya* says:

56:35	We developed them in a particular way (developed them with great finesse)	إِنَّا أَنْشَأْنَاهُمْ إِنْشَاءً
56:91	you may be given a new form of birth of which you are unaware	وَنُنْشِئُكُمْ فِي مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ

“مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ” (*ma la ta’lamoon*) makes it obvious that as far as human knowledge is concerned, we cannot know the condition in the hereafter. This has been likened to a new creation at other places (17:39, 17:98, 32:10).

Surah *Al-Waqiya* a little further on says:

56:73	Do you make that tree grow and develop or is it We who continuously do so?	ءَأَنْتُمْ أَنْشَأْتُمْ شَجَرَتَهَا أَمْ نَحْنُ الْمُنْشِئُونَ
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The Quran says:

43:18	Who is brought up among jewellery (referring to the environment in which women were brought up)	مَنْ يُنْشَأُ فِي الْحُلِيِّةِ
13:12	He who raises big dark clouds from the sea into the air	وَيُنْشِئُ السَّحَابَ الثِّقَالَ
55:24	boats with high sails	جَوَارِ الْمُنْشَآتِ
73:6	The rising in the night	نَاشِئَةَ اللَّيْلِ

To nurture or develop, to progress gradually, to make grow, are all the traits of Allah who is the great Sustainer. Everything in the universe follows the laws of Allah and gradually is developed towards its end. This will have to be done by the humans in this world too, i.e. the development of every individual and beyond in a Society. Every believer will have to strive to enable the development of other individuals of the society and mankind. This is the very purpose of Islam.

”النَّشْرُ“ (*an-nashru*): the air, fragrant air or wind, fragrance. The element of spreading all over is predominant in this word {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says this means “to open something and for that thing to branch out”.

”النَّشِيرُ“ (*an'nashbiru*): to open something, or to spread.

”نَشَرَ الْخَشَبَةَ“ (*nasharal khashabah*): he split the wood.

”الْمَنْشَارُ“ (*al-minsharu*): the saw.

”النَّشَارَةُ“ (*an'nisharatu*): saw dust that falls while splitting wood.

”النَّشْرُ“ (*an'nashru*): to spread the news, or for the leaves to spread. It also means for the trees to be full of leaves.

”نَشَرَتِ الْأَرْضُ نُشُورًا“ (*nsasharatil arzu nushura*): with the advent of spring the land became alive i.e. plants grew up bountifully.

”النَّشْرُ“ (*an'nashru*): dry grass that once again turns green due to rainfall at the end of summer.

”النَّشِيرُ“ (*an'nasheeru*): the crops that have been cut but not taken away.

”أَنْشَرَ الْأَرْضَ“ (*ansharal arz*): he watered the land and thus gave it a new life.

”النَّشُورُ“ (*an'nashuur*): new life {*T, R, M*}.

This word has been used by the Quran to mean everything stated above.

The Quran says:

17:13	open book	كِتَابًا... مَنْشُورًا
52:3	within the spreading or overwhelming book;	فِي رَقٍّ مَنْشُورٍ
54:7	spreading, (overwhelming or swarm)	جَرَادٌ مُنْتَشِرٌ
33:53	After you have eaten then spread out	فَإِذَا طَعِمْتُمْ فَانْتَشِرُوا
77:3	The forces that can spread to a long distance	وَالنَّشِيبَاتِ لَنْتَشِرْنَ
25:47	Allah has made the night for you so that you may rest and the day to walk around	وَجَعَلَ النَّهَارَ نُشُورًا

In Surah *Al-Furqaan* it is said about the helplessness of the idols:

25:3	they do not possess the power of life or death or of new life after death	لَا يَمْلِكُونَ مَوْتًا وَلَا حَيَاةً وَلَا نُشُورًا
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This new life can be seen in the dead land receiving some life giving water and the latent greenery spreads out on the land. As such, after explaining such condition of land it is said:

35:9	In the same way your new life will be given	كَذَٰلِكَ النُّشُورُ
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Imagine how explicit this example is of new life, i.e. that thing does possess the ingredients of life, but in their latent form and only with the help of a new process (of creation) that sleep or latent-ness is replaced by awakening.

Those who deny a life after death say:

44:35	we cannot get new life (once we die)	مَا نَحْنُ بِمُنشَرِينَ
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But it is said that this thinking is completely wrong. Allah is one who can give new life to man after he dies in this life:

80:22	A dead body is stagnant and still, but a live person grows and develops. The symbol of life is to grow and spread out.	أَمَاتَهُ فَأَمَّنَّ ثُمَّ إِذَا شَاءَ أَنْشَرَهُ
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”النَّشْرُ“ (*an-nashr*): anything that does not grow and hence is devoid of life. The nation which is stagnant and does not move ahead is practically dead.

“النَّشْرُ” (*an-nashzu*) and “النَّشَزُ” (*an-nashaz*): a high and lofty place.

“نَشَرَ” (*nashaza*): he climbed the high place and became safe.

“نَشَرَ الرَّجُلُ” (*nashazar rajul*): the man who was sitting stood up.

“نَشَرَ بِالْقَوْمِ فِي الْخُصُومَةِ” (*nashaza bil qaumi fil khusumah*): he stood up or was prepared to fight the nation {*T, Ibn Faris*}.

Raghib says that “نَشَرَ” (*nashaza*) means for something to move away from its place. This has led to “نُشُوزٌ” (*nushuz*) which means for the husband or wife to start opposition e.g., to be abhorrent, to fight, to misbehave, to oppose each other, for the woman to stand opposition to the man (3:34) and for the man to oppose the woman (4:128).

In Surah *Al-Mujadlah* this word has appeared to mean “for one to leave a meeting” or “to stand up in a meeting” (58:11).

In Surah *Al-Baqrah* it has appeared to mean “to lift” the bones, or “to make them lofty” and “to highlight” them (2:259).

“نَشَطَ مِنَ الْمَكَانِ” (*nashatal minal makan*): he went out of that place, i.e. he left the place.

“النَّاشِطُ” (*an-naashitu*): the wild ox that goes from one place to another.

“أَنْشَطَ الْعُقْدَ” (*anshatal uqdatah*): he opened the knot {*T*}.

“أَنْشَطَ الْبَعِيرَ مِنْ عِقَالِهِ” (*anshatal ba'eera min iqalih*): he opened the tether of the camel and freed it {*M*}.

“نَشَطَ” (*nashatun*): to tie a knot that can be opened easily {*R*}.

“نَشِطَ” (*nashita*), “يَنْشِطُ” (*yanshatu*), “نَشَاطٌ” (*nashata*): to be happy at being given some work, or to be happy or prepared to, to be interested in that piece of work. It also means (figuratively) for the knots of the heart to open {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to swoon and to move.

The Quran says:

79:3	the planets that revolve fast from one place to another	النَّشِطَاتِ نَشَاطًا
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“تَنْشَطَتِ النَّاقَةُ فِي سَيْرِهَا” (*tanash shat tin naaqah fee sairih*): the camel was very fast {*T*}:

“إِنْشَطَ الْحَبْلُ” (*intashatil habl*): he pulled on the rope till it opened.

“نَشَطَ الدَّلْوَمِنَ الْبِئْرِ” (*nashatad dalwa minal bir*): he pulled on the well bucket {*M*} i.e. without moving the wooden frame.

“وَالنَّاشِطَاتِ نَشَاطًا” (*wan-na'shitaatin nashta*): is a hint at the mutual gravity of the planets, i.e. which revolve quite fast and also maintain their gravitational pull. In other words “they are free or their knots” and are “untied” but at the same time the gravitational pull binds them together.

There is speed and expansion and discipline in it too. In this one word “نَشَطَ” (*nasht*), the whole world of these planets or stars is reflected.

Maulana Obaidullah Sindhi says that “وَالنَّاشِطَاتِ نَشَاطًا” (*wannaa shitaati nashta*) means that the obstacles in the way of man's development are removed by this revolutionary group of the believers. This group has a mission to remove the obstacles in the way of mankind.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “to keep something straight”.

“النَّصْبُ” (*an-nasb*): to support something to stand erect, to highlight something {*R*}.

“نَصَبَ الشَّجَرَةَ” (*nasabash shajaratah*): to plant a sapling in the earth {*M*}.

“النَّصْبُ” (*an-nasb*): embedded flag.

“النَّصْبُ” (*an-nusub*) and “النَّصِيبُ” (*an-naseeb*): anything which is embedded and becomes a symbol or sign.

The plural is “الْأَنْصَابُ” (*an-naseeb*) {*T*} which was also used for “raised stones”. Later it came to mean “fixed share” {*R*}.

“النَّصِيبُ” (*ansaab*) are also the stones embedded around the *Ka’ba* on which animals were slaughtered.

This led to the word meaning “fixed share”.

“النَّصَابُ” (*an-nisaab*): the centre of anything {*T*}.

“جَعَلْتُهُ نَصَبَ عَيْنِي” (*ja’alatahu nusba aini*): I fixed it before my eyes so that I can neither ignore it nor forget it {*T*}, i.e. made it my reason to live.

“نَصِبَ” (*nasiba*), “يَنْصِبُ” (*yansabu*): to become tired and become unrequited and deprived {*T*}. This probably means so because one who is tired is left standing at one place.

“النَّصْبُ” (*an-nasab*): hard labour, tiredness, stress.

“عِيشَتُنَا نَصِيبٌ” (*aishoon naasib*): a hard life.

“النَّصْبُ” (*an-nisbu*) and “النَّصَبُ” (*an-nasbu*), “النَّصْبُ” (*an-nusbu*): sickness, misery and trial & tribulation {*T*}.

The Quran says:

15:48	They will not feel any tiredness, labour or any kind of trouble in <i>Jannah</i> .	لَا يَعْشُهُمْ فِيهَا نَصَبٌ
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Here this has appeared to mean “share” (4:7, 2:202)

Surah *An-Nisaa* says “نَصِيبٌ” (*naseebun*) and “كِفْلٌ” (*kiflun*) as alternatives in (4:85).

The Quran says:

5:3	The stone or place where sacrifices are made in the name of others than God	وَمَا دُبِجَ عَلَى النَّصْبِ
70:43	as if they are running towards these (sacrificial) places	كَأَنَّهُمْ إِلَىٰ نُصُبٍ يُوفِضُونَ
88:3	The people who are tired after hard labour	عَامِلَةٌ نَّاصِبَةٌ

Every work entails effort. If the labour is done rightly then one gets the desired result, and this sort of hard work does not create any feeling of tiredness, but if the labour is done towards wrong paths then the labour fails to produce the desired result, and the labour creates a feeling of tiredness or futility.

These deeds are “عَامِلَةٌ نَّاصِبَةٌ” (*aamilatun naasibah*) as used in (88:3). They did not work or act according to Allah’s laws, and therefore did not produce the desired results and led to tiredness and deprivation.

Surah *Saad* says that *Ayub* called out to Allah:

38:41	A snake has bit me due to which I am in extreme pain	أَنَّىٰ مَسَّنِيَ الشَّيْطَانُ بِنُصْبٍ
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Surah *Al-Faatir* uses “نَصَبٌ” (*nasabun*) and “لُغُوبٌ” (*laghub*) in (35:35) i.e. physical labour and tiredness.

Surah *Al-Ahzaaf* says that *Moosa* said to his companion:

18:62	I am tired due to this journey	لَقَدْ لَقِينَا مِنْ سَفَرِنَا هَذَا نَصَبًا
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Surah *Al-Inshraah* says:

94:7	Now that opposition has been removed, the second part of your program should begin for which you have to struggle further	فَإِذَا فَرَغْتَ فَانصَبْ
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“نَصَبَ” (*nasiba*), “يَنْصِبُ فِي الْأَمْرِ” (*yansubu fil amr*): to struggle {*M*}.

Ordinarily a program is completed if there is no more opposition but the establishment of Allah’s program demands that after the opposition ends, the second part of the program begins. The end of opposition is the first or ‘*la*’ part. After it the ‘*illa*’ part (that is, the constructive phase) starts. Thus the entire life of this group (of *momineen*) is spent in making effort.

N-Sd-T

ن ص ت

“نَصَتَ الرَّجُلُ” (*nasatar rajulu*): the silent man.

“أَنْصَتَ” (*ansat*) is more expressive as compared to “نَصَتَ” (*nasata*) and means “to become silent”, “to be quiet”, “to quieten in order to listen to someone” {*T, M*}.

“أَنْصِتُوا” (*wansitu*): when the Quran is recited then be quiet and listen to it (7:204).

N-Sd-H

ن ص ح

“نَصَحَ” (*nasih*): to sew and to purify or cleanse honey.

“نَصَحَ الشَّيْءُ” (*nasahash shaiyi*): the thing became pure.

“النَّاصِحُ” (*an-naasih*): pure honey.

“نَصَحَ الْخَيَّاطُ الثَّوْبَ” (*nasahal khayyatus saub*): the tailor sews the cloth very expertly or well {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “to bring two things together” or “create harmony between two things”.

“النُّصْحُ” (*un-nushu*) and “النَّصِيحَةُ” (*an-naseeha*): the opposite of fraud and defraud.

“النَّاصِحُ” (*un-naasih*) and “النَّصَّاحُ” (*an-nassahu*): a tailor.

“النَّصَّاحُ” (*an-nisaahu*): thread.

“النَّصَّاحُ” (*al-minsahah*): needle.

“النَّصِيحَةُ” (*nash’un*): to mend (a rupture in the cloth), to sew somebody’s ruptured cloth with all pureness of the heart, i.e. with no ulterior motive, to be somebody’s well-wisher {*T, M*}.

The messengers used to tell their people:

7:62	I have come for your correction to correct you or mend your ways	وَأَنْصَحْ لَكُمْ
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In other words the messengers said that they were all trying with all sincerity to mend the ruptured cloth of humanity and asked their nations to return to Allah’s guidance so that they may not be misled and go astray. These messengers told their people to adhere to this path (Allah’s guidance) very sincerely and adopt it to draw its benefits which will never end.

N-Sd-R

ن ص ر

“نَصَرَ الْغَيْثُ الْأَرْضَ” (*nasaral ghaisul ard*): the rain made the land green again.

“أَرْضٌ مَنْصُورَةٌ” (*ardun mansoorah*): the land where rainfall has taken place.

“النَّوَاصِرُ” (*un-nawasir*) is the plural of “نَاصِرٌ” (*naasir*) or “نَاصِرَةٌ” (*naasirah*) and means “the water courses that have flowed into a valley from afar”.

Abu Haneefah says that “نَاصِرٌ” (*nasirun*) and “نَاصِرَةٌ” (*naasirah*) means “the water which comes a long way and helps the flood advance” {*T, M*}.

Ibn Qateebah says that “نَصْرٌ” (*nasrun*) means “to provide sustenance”.

Ibn Faris says this root basically means bring “to give good things”.

“النَّصْرُ” (*an-nasru*) has also been said to mean “gift” or “award”. Thus it means “the cultivation which makes the land green”.

The Quran calls the group which lives according to the laws of Allah as “مُفْلِحُونَ” (*muflihoon*) as in (2:5), i.e. “those whose fields are green, whose crops are successful”. See heading (**F-L-H**). Allah’s law is that rain which makes their deeds bear fruit. This is why “نُصْرَةٌ” (*nusrat*) means the victory which God provide. Those deeds which are not according to Allah’s law are like the labours of a farmer which are unsuccessful because they lack rain water. These have been called “أَخْسَرِينَ أَعْمَالًا” (*ukhsareena aamala*) and “ضَلَّ سَبِيلَهُمْ” (*zalla sa’yuhum*) in (18:103-104) i.e. “those whose efforts were unsuccessful, and their trade gave them a big loss” while they thought they are going in the right direction.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* has “نَصَرَ” (*nasara*) as against “خَذَلَ” (*khazala*) which means to leave someone’s side. Therefore “نَصَرَ” (*nasara*) means “to side with someone”.

Since water helps crops to grow, “نَصْرٌ” (*nasrun*) means “to help” and “to assist”.

Muheet has explained the difference between help and victory.

“نُصْرَةٌ” (*nusrat*) particularly means to get rid of bad things and “مَعُونَةٌ” (*ma-unat*) is general assistance.
 “إِسْتَنْصَارٌ” (*istinsaar*): to call for help.
 “إِسْتَنْصَارُهُ عَلَى فُلَانٍ” (*istansara ala fulanun*): asked him for help against someone.
 “إِنتَصَرَ” (*intasar*): he was safe from the oppressor’s oppression, he obtained justice, he was avenged {**T, M**}.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says:

21:68	Speak highly of your idols	وَانصُرُوا آلِهَتَكُمْ
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It has been mentioned earlier that Allah’s “نُصْرَةٌ” (*nusrat*) or help means the fruits that are acquired by adopting His laws. Thus Allah’s “نُصْرَةٌ” (*nusrat*) or help is not received by merely sitting around and doing nothing.

The Quran says:

47:7	Those with conviction, if you help Allah then surely He will help you	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِن تَنْصُرُوا اللَّهَ يَنْصُرْكُمْ
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Helping Allah means to establish His system in this world and follow His laws. If you do so then the benefits of this system will certainly accompany you, and this will result in:

47:7	He will steady your legs: you will be granted stability by him	وَيُثَبِّتْ أَقْدَامَكُمْ
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Those who refuse to follow His laws:

47:8	their deeds will remain go waste despite making effort	أَصْلَ أَعْمَالِهِمْ
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Surah *Al-Hoodh* says:

11:30	Who is able protect me from Allah’s punishment? (Who can help me against Allah?)	مَنْ يَنْصُرُنِي مِنَ اللَّهِ
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If I violate the laws of Allah then who can save me from the destructive results of those deeds?

The Quran says:

42:39	When somebody commits excesses against them then they protect themselves	وَالَّذِينَ إِذَا أَصَابَهُمُ الْبَغْيُ هُمْ يَنْتَصِرُونَ
47:4	to avenge oppression	وَلَوْ يَشَاءُ اللَّهُ لَأَنْتَصَرْنَاهُمْ
54:10	I am overpowered (and cannot do anything) so you avenge	أَنْتَى مَغْلُوبٌ فَانْتَصِرْ

	me	
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The Quran has used “الْأَنْصَارُ” (*al-ansaar*) against the “the migrants” in (9:100). It means the believers of *Medina* who helped the migrants and thus Allah’s system was established there. Generally “أَنْصَارُ اللَّهِ” (*ansaar-ullaah*) means those who assist the way of Allah (3:52).

Nasara نَصَارَى

“نَصْرَانِي” (*nasara*): the followers of *Isa* (Jesus) as described in (2:111). The singular is “نَصْرَانِي” (*nasraaniyyu*) as in (3:66). The plural of “نَصْرَان” (*nasraan*) and “نَصْرَانِي” (*nasraani*) is “نَصَارَى” (*nasara*).

N-Sd-F ن ص ف

“نِصْف” (*nisf*), “نَصْف” (*nasf*), “نُصْف” (*nusf*): one equal part of something divided in two, or one of two equal parts of something, i.e. “half”.

The Quran says:

4:11	for them it is half	فَلَهَا النِّصْفُ
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“الْإِنْصَافُ فِي الْمَعَامَلَةِ” (*al-insaafu fil mu’aamala*): to provide as much benefit to somebody as one receives from him, to justify your salary, if he demands rights then let him discharge his obligations too {*R*}.

The Quran has used the words “عَدْل” (*adal*) and “قِسْط” (*qist*). It has not used the word “انصاف” (*insaaf*) which we today use for “justice” or “justified equal share”.

Ibn Faris says “الْإِنْصَافُ فِي الْمَعَامَلَةِ” (*al-insaafu fil mu’amala*) means “to be content with half”.

N-Sd-W ن ص و

“النَّاصِيَةِ” (*an-naasiyah*): the front part of the head or the further most hairlines on the front part of the head {*T*}. But most dictionaries do not stress the front part of the head. It also means “the hair near the forehead”. The plural is “النَّوَاصِي” (*an-nawasi*). Figuratively this word is used to mean “respect” and “honour” {*T*}.

“فُلَانٌ نَاصِيَةُ قَوْمٍ” (*fulanun naasiyatu qaumihi*): he is the leader of his nation or people {*R*}.

Ibn Faris says it means “to select the better thing” or “a thing to embody grandeur and importance”.

“أَخَذَ بِنَاصِيَتِهِ” (*akhaza unaasiyah*): to catch hold of the forelocks, to make someone helpless and seize him.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:56	And every living thing is within Allah’s grasp. (His law is over everybody, nobody is beyond his law, everyone is bound within His laws)	وَمَا مِنْ دَابَّةٍ إِلَّا هُوَ آخِذٌ بِنَاصِيَتِهَا
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Surah *Ar-Rahman* says:

55:41	They will be held by their forelocks and their feet: they will be in full grip.	فَيُؤْخَذُ بِالنَّوَاصِي وَالْأَقْدَامِ
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“نَضِجَ الثَّمَرُ” (*nazijas samara*): the fruit ripened fully.
 “هُوَ نَضِيجُ الرَّأْيِ” (*huwa nazeejur raaya*): he has firm and mature opinion {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means “to ripen something to the ultimate limit”.

Figuratively this word is used to mean “very mature”. This word is also used to mean “cook by fire”.

“أَنْضَجَ الطَّاهِي اللَّحْمَ” (*anzajat taahil lahm*): the chef cooked the meat so much that it gave way and its elements separated from each other {T}.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:56	their strength and solidness will end	كُلَّمَا نَضِجَتْ جُلُودُهُمْ
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Here “نَضِجَ” (*nazija*) doesn’t mean “to reach maturity”. It means “to soften” or “disintegrate by being cooked”. For details see (J-L-D).

“نَضَخَهُ” (*nazakhahu*), “يَنْضَخُهُ” (*yanzakhahu*): sprinkled on him.
 “نَضَخَ الْمَاءُ” (*nazakhal ma’u*): for water to boil with a gush, for water to gush forth from a stream.
 “عَيْنٌ نَضَّاخَةٌ” (*ainun nazzakhatahu*): a stream which gushes forth {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says it means “a stream with abundant water”.

The Quran while speaking of the gardens of Eden has said they contain:

55:66	Streams which gush forth. (Those fountains which take one to loftiness with their internal strength)	عَيْنٍ نَضَّاخَتَيْنِ
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“نَضَدَ مَتَاعَهُ” (*nazada mata’ahu*), “يَنْضِدُ” (*yanzid*): stack one’s things one upon another, to put some things over something according to a pattern. The goods kept in this way will be called “نَضِيدٌ” (*nazeedun*), “مَنْضُودٌ” (*munzood*) {T, M, R}.

Hence this root basically means “layer upon layer” (56:29, 50:10).

Ibn Faris says it means “to put some things according to a certain order along with other things, whether they are kept straight or width wise”.

“الْأَنْضَادُ مِنَ الْجِبَالِ” (*al-anzaad minal jibaal*): rocks or mountains which have layers.
 “الْأَنْضَادُ مِنَ السَّحَابِ” (*al-anzaadu minas sahaab*): the clouds which are over one another in layers {T, M, R}.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:82	We rained continuously stones on them in layers	وَ أَطْرَقْنَا عَلَيْهَا حِجَارَةً مِنْ سِجِّيلٍ مَنْضُودٍ
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“النَّزْرَةُ” (*an-nazrah*): happiness and well-being, earnings, strength, beauty.

“النَّضَارَةُ” (*an-nazaarah*): the beauty and brightness of the face.

“النَّازِرُ” (*an-naazir*): anything which is dark green in color.

“النُّضَارُ” (*an-nazar*): the pure element of gold etc.

“قَدْ أَنْضَرَ الشَّجَرُ” (*qad anzarash shajar*): leaves of the tree turned green {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is “beauty and purity”.

The Quran says:

75:22	On that day some faces will be fresh and lively (They will have pleasure and freshness)	وَجْهُ هَيَّوْمَئِذٍ نَاضِرٌ
76:11	You will find their faces to be bright (This will be the characteristic by which they will be recognized)	وَلَقَدْ لَكُم نَصْرَةٌ وَسُرُورًا
83:24	You will find their faces to be bright (This will be the characteristic by which they will be distinguished and recognised)	تَعْرِفُ فِي وُجُوهِهِمْ نَصْرَةَ الرَّحِيمِ

This is the situation with those in the heaven.

“نَطَحَ” (*nataha*), “يَنْطَحُ” (*yantihu*): it hit him with the horns.

“النَّطِيحَةُ” (*an-nateeha*): the animals which die due to another animal hitting them with their horns {T}.

“النَّوَاطِحُ” (*an-nawatih*): miseries and difficulties {T}.

The Quran says it is forbidden to partake.

“النُّطْفَةُ” (*an-nutfah*): clear water, rather abundant or little, but this word is particular to mean little water for the Arabs.

“نُطْفَةٍ” (*an-nutfah*): sperm, sea or river.

“نَطَفَ الْمَاءُ” (*natafal ma'i*): the water flowed or spilled, or dropped in small parts {M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “wetness and humidity” and said it is figuratively said in order to become muddy, and it is used mostly in an execrable sense.

“شَيْءٌ نَطْفٌ” (*shaiyun nutfah*): a faulty thing.

The noble Quran has said at a place about the creation of man that it has been created from “نُطْفَةٍ” (*nutaf*).

“نُطِقَ” (*nutq*): to make loud sound with words which give a clear meaning.

The sound of animals is not called “نُطِقَ” (*nutq*) but “صَوْتُ” (*saut*).

“أَنْطَقَهُ اللَّهُ” (*antaqahul laah*): Allah called him to Him {T, M}.

Muheet says that “نُطِقَ” (*nutqis*) particularly means “human speech”. It is also said to make something understandable.

“نَطَقَ الْكِتَابُ” (*nataq al-kitaba*): the book made the matter understandable.

“النَّاطِقَةُ” (*an-naqitah*): womb.

“النُّطَاقُ” (*an-nitah*): that ribbon, band or belt which is worn around the waist.

Raghib says “نُطِقَ” (*nutq*) is such a word that encompasses the meaning of something.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings:

- 1) Speech or something similar
- 2) A sort of dress which encompasses one's waist.

The Quran says:

21:63	If they talk	إِنْ كَانُوا يَنْطِقُونَ
45:29	This Book of Ours clarifies everything with the truth.	هَذَا كِتَابُنَا يَنْطِقُ عَلَيْكُمْ بِالْحَقِّ

At another place it appears that those who will go to hellish conditions say to their bodies “how dare you present evidence against us” they will say:

41:21	We have been granted the power of speech by Allah who has enabled others to speak	أَنْطَقَنَا اللَّهُ الَّذِي أَنْطَقَ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ
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Obviously here “نُتْقَ” (*nutq*) does not mean “to talk” but to somehow “express the truth”, just as we say that “every move that we make, speaks....”

Surah *An-Namal* says that *Suleman* was taught “مَنْطِقُ الطَّيْرِ” (*muntiqat tair*) in (27:16). It is usually taken to mean “speech of the birds”. It may figuratively mean “the rules of a horse brigade”. See heading (*Te-Y-R*). If it is taken to mean “speech of the birds”, it will mean the movements and sounds with which man can understand what birds are saying. This thing can be obtained by observation and knowing about how the birds behave, but generally we prefer the literal meaning.

N-Ze-R ن ظ ر

“نَظَرَ” (*nazar*), “يَنْظُرُ” (*yanzur*): to see with the eyes, to deliberate upon something, to assess.
 “النَّظَارُ” (*an-nizaar*): eloquence, to give attention.
 “أَنْظُرْنِي” (*unzurni*): pay attention to me or refer to me {*T*}.

Ibn Faris too says that it means “to deliberate” and “to inspect”. The word also means “to wait”.

“نَظَرْتُهُ” (*mazarttyahu*), “الْتَنَظَّرْتُه” (*antazartahu*): I waited for his arrival.
 “أَنْظَرَهُ” (*anzarahu*): to give more to me.

The Quran says:

15:37	He (<i>Iblees</i>) said “my Sustainer, give time till the day of the rising”. (God said) “You are among those who have been given time”.	قَالَ رَبِّ فَأَنْظِرْنِي إِلَى يَوْمٍ يُبْعَثُونَ قَالِ فَإِنَّكَ مِنَ الْمُنْظَرِينَ
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Surah *Al-Baqrah* says that if the borrower is “تَوَفَّنَظِرَةً إِلَى مَيْسَرَةٍ” (*fanziratun ila maisarah*) i.e. hard pressed, then he should be given more time (to repay the loan) (2:280).

“تَتَنَاظَرُ” (*tanaazar*): to be face to face.
 “النَّظِيرُ” (*an-nazeer*): similarity and to be like something.
 “النَّظَرُ” (*an-nazeer*): this too in similarity.
 “النَّظَرَةُ” (*an-nazarah*): fault and bad shape.
 “الْمَنْظُورُ” (*al-manzoor*): faulty {*T, R*}.

In *Ibrahim*’s case, it has been said:

37:88	That nation worshipped the stars	فَتَنَظَّرَ نَظَرَةً فِي النُّجُومِ
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Ibrahim deliberated on the stars and told the people what faults they have due to which they could not be gods, i.e. the stars are themselves dependant on something to rise and fall. Thus those who are self-sufficient and independent could never be gods. They are bound to sink. After this he said:

37:89	I reject (am frustrated with) such gods (I cannot worship them)	إِنِّي سَفِيمٌ
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“نَظَرْلَهُمْ” (*nazara lahum*): became sympathetic to them and helped them.
 “نَظَرَبَيْنَهُمْ” (*nazara bainahum*): decided between them {*T, R*}.

Despite that “نَظَرَ” (*nazar*) also means “to reflect” but it has been used by the Quran for its basic meaning, that is “to see”. This is why Quran has distinguished the meaning of “نَظَرَ” (*nazar*) and “بَصَرَ” (*basar*).

The Quran says:

7:198	You shall see that they will be looking at you, but will not be reflecting upon your words.	وَتَرَاهُمْ يَنْظُرُونَ إِلَيْكَ وَهُمْ لَا يُبْصِرُونَ
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Such ‘seers’ are called “الْعُمَى” (*al-ummi*) by the Quran i.e. “blind” (10:43). Those are people whose eyes of the mind go blind (22:46).

“النَّعْجُ” (*an-na’aj*): to be plump.

“نَعَجَتِ الْإِبِلُ” (*na’ijatal ibl*): the camels became plump.

“النَّاعِجَةُ” (*an-na’ijah*): soft and smooth land which gives good product.

“النَّعْجَةُ” (*an-na’jah*): female sheep, a doe, or mountain goat {T}.

The plural is “نِعَاجٌ” (*ni’aaaj*). The Quran has used it both as singular and plural in (38:23) and (38:24).

“النُّعَاسُ” (*an-nu’aas*): the silence and quiet that is produced due to heaviness of sleep {M}.

Muheet says with reference to **Keys**, that sleep or “نَوْمٌ” (*naum*) is a condition where the senses become suspended and “نُعَاسٌ” (*nu’aas*) is the initial stage of that stupor. Some say that “سِنَةٌ” (*sinatun*) is a condition when the head feels heavy due to sleep.

“نُعَاسٌ” (*nu’aas*) is felt when the eyelids become heavy and “نَوْمٌ” (*naum*) is that heaviness which is felt in the heart {M}.

Raghib says that “نُعَاسٌ” (*nu’aas*) is “نَوْمٌ قَلِيلٌ” (*naum qaleel*), that is “short sleep” and says that the Quran refers to peace and quiet by using it in (8:11).

The Quran says:

8:11	when Allah cast <i>nu’aas</i> over you to create peace and contentment	إِذْ يُغَشِّيكُمُ النُّعَاسَ أَمَنَةً
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Also in (3:153) it means peace and contentment, not stupor.

“نُعَاقُ الرَّاعِي بِغَنَمِهِ” (*na’aqar raahi bighanmihi*), “يَنْعِقُ” (*yan’iq*), “نُعَاقًا” (*nu’aaqa*): for the shepherd to scold or talk harshly to the herd in order to drive it forward {T, M, F}.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** talks about the people who move on with their eyes and ears closed and blindly follow their elders without thinking. They have been likened to a sheep or goat herd which heeds the call of the shepherd rather than their own intellect. Even the shepherd’s voice is a sound and not anything else which has no meaning as such. Those who follow blindly also do not know any meaning of this sound.

Whatever they are told about the old traditions and customs, they just follow it.

17:1-2	The unbeliever is like someone who is being called but who does not understand anything beyond the call or its sound (those who follow blindly without exercising their intellect)	مَثَلُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا كَمَثَلِ الْإِنْعِقِ بِمَا لَا يَسْمَعُ إِلَّا دُعَاءً وَنِدَاءً
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Note how correctly the Quran has depicted what we call our ‘*deen*’ today. The masses are like the sheep who have a shepherd at their back (or the *mullas*) who make them follow blindly what their forefathers have told them and they keep reciting them (the verses) without understanding them, and the masses follow them blindly.

Ibn Faris says “نَعْلٌ” (*naal*) basically means for something to be steep or the lower part.

“النَّعْلُ” (*an-naal*): shoe or anything that protects a foot from touching the ground {T}.

Surah *Taha* says that *Moosa* was told:

20:12	Take off both your shoes (sit comfortably and listen with equanimity)	فَاخْلَعْ نَعْلَيْكَ
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For details, see heading (*Kh-L-Ain*).

“نَعِمَ بِهِ عَيْنًا” (*na'ima bihi aina*): he found something to be soothing to the eyes and comforting for the heart.

“تَنْعِيمَةٌ” (*taneemah*): is a plant with very green leaves and grows on water which does not let its freshness lessen.

“تَوْبٌ نَاعِمٌ” (*saubun naa'im*): a cloth which is very soft and comfortable.

“نُعَامِي” (*nu'aami*): the south wind which is refreshing and which is more humid than other winds.

“النَّاعِمَةُ” (*an-na'imah*), “الْمُنَاعِمَةُ” (*al-munaa'imatu*) and “الْمُنْعَمَةُ” (*al-munaa*): a woman who is living a happy life and who is very cheerful {T, M}. These words also mean the collectiveness and unity of a nation.

“إِنُّنَّ النَّعَامِيَّةَ” (*abn-un-a'amah*): that one person who stays besides a well to offer water to others.

“شَا لَتْ نَعَامَتُهُمْ” (*shaalat na'aamatuhum*): they scattered.

“النَّعْمَةُ” (*an-ni'mah*): the condition in which a man feels pleasure {T, M}. It also means happiness, wealth, wellbeing and or philanthropy {T}

These meanings expostulate that “نِعْمَتٌ” (*ne'mat*) means for every facet of social life being soft (or easy), delightful, happy, high and away from any difficulty or misery.

Surah *An-Nahal* says after talking about the paraphernalia of life:

16:81	Thus He completes his favour upon you.	كَذَٰلِكَ يُسِّمُ نِعْمَتَهُ عَلَيْكُمْ
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This makes the meaning clear.

Surah *Luqmaan* calls these paraphernalia of life as “نِعْمَتُ اللَّهِ” (*ne'matullah*) which is taken from one place to another by boats (31:31).

In Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* the victory and spoils of war have also been called “نِعْمَتٌ” (*ne'mat*) (3:173).

In Surah *An-Nahal*, the word “ضَرَرٌ” (*zarar*) which means “loss” or “harm” has been used against “نِعْمَتٌ” (*ne'mat*) and this makes the latter's meaning clear, i.e., to stay away from the miseries and difficulties of life.

Surah *Ad-Dukhaan* calls all the good things in life as “نِعْمَةٌ” (*ne'mat*) (44:27).

Surah *Al-Ghashia* uses “نَاعِمَةٌ” (*na'imah*) against “خَاشِعَةٌ” (*khaashia*) and “نَاصِبَةٌ” (*naasibah*) which mean “frustration” “sadness”, “demeaned” and “insult”. Therefore “نَاعِمَةٌ” (*na'imah*) means “good things in life”.

Surah *Ibrahim* uses “نِعْمَتُ اللَّهِ” (*ne'matul-laah*) against “كُفْرٌ” (*kufir*) in (14:28) which may mean non-acknowledgement or ungratefulness for life's pleasantries. Hence this word refers to loftiness and guidance from Allah.

“نَاعِمَةٌ” (*na'imah*): encompassing freshness and evergreen (8:88).

“نَعْمَةٌ” (*ne'mah*): wellbeing (44:27).

“نِعْمَةٌ” (*ne'matun*): benevolence, kindness and favour (26:22). The plural is “أَنْعَمٌ” (*anum*). Everything in the universe that has been subjugated to human beings is “نِعْمَةٌ” (*ne'mah*) (14: 32-34).

“نِعْمَةٌ” (*ne'mah*): to get superiority over nations (2:47).

The word “نِعْمَةٌ” (*ne'mah*) has also appeared to mean mental benefits as well as physical (68:2, 52:29), and also to mean physical health and cleanliness (5:1).

The Quran has said that the nation which is at the pinnacle of life is “نِعْمَةُ اللَّهِ” (*mun'im alaih*), and prayers have been taught to human beings to be able to follow in their footsteps (1:6). By keeping all the above mentioned traits in mind, one can very well glean how a nation with “نِعْمَةٌ” (*ne'mah*) would be – the Quran has explained it. People of such a nation have been said to be *momin*. Therefore those who do not possess all this or who do not struggle to acquire all these cannot be considered to be *momin* according to the Quran.

“نَعْمٌ” (*na'am*): it is very good indeed.

“نَعْمَ الْمَآدُونَ” (*ne'mal maahidoon*): We are a very good provider of the wherewithal of life (51:28).

“نِعْمًا يَعْطِيكُمْ بِهِ” (*ne'imma yu'izukum bihi*): it is a very good thing he is advising you about (4:58).

“نِعْمًا” (*ne'ma*) is actually “نَعْمٌ” (*nem*) plus “مَا” (*ma*).

“نَعْمُو” (*naamu*) and “نَعْمٌ” (*na'am*), the plural of which is “أَنْعَامٌ” (*an'aam*) means domestic animals. To the Arabs this word generally means camels, goats or cows. Some have included sheep and other such animals too, but others have said it means camels only {T}.

The Quran has included all four domestic animals in the meaning of this word, i.e. camels, cattle, sheep and goats (39:6, 6:144 -45).

The Quran says:

22:30	And are made lawfull to you the cattle except what is recited to you	وَأُحِلَّتْ لَكُمْ بَهِيمَةُ الْأَنْعَامِ إِلَّا مَا يُنْتَلَىٰ عَلَيْكُمْ
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Also see (5:1).

This specific order is a couple of verses later in which the dead, blood, pig meat, and anything which is slaughtered in the name of non-Allah is forbidden (5:3).

As mentioned under the heading (*B-H-M*), “بَهِيمَةٌ” (*bahimah*) means that which cannot speak. As such “” (*bahimal in'aam*) would mean those animals who do not have the power to speak. Like they say in English “” (the dumb cattle). This means that this word is the characteristic of animals. It does not mean that those animals which are dumb are permitted to eat, and others which can speak are not.

“أَنْعَامٌ” (*an'aam*) are all dumb, and as mentioned above, the Quran has included camels, cattle, goats and sheep among them. But as will be explained ahead, “بَهِيمَةُ الْأَنْعَامِ” (*bahimatl in'aam*) includes all animals which graze.

Surah *Al-Faatir* distinguishes human beings from “ذَوَابٌّ” (*dawa'abb*) in (35:28), although “ذَوَابٌّ” (*dawa'abb*) includes all animals. See heading (*D, B-B*). But here “ذَوَابٌّ” (*dawa'abb*) would mean animals that crawl, and “” (*an'aam*) would mean the four legged animals.

Surah *Taha* says “eat plants or vegetation yourself as well as feed your “أَنْعَامٌ” (*an'aam*) on it (80:32, 79:33, 32:27, 10:24, 30:54). This shows obviously that “أَنْعَامٌ” (*an'aam*) are the animals which graze, which you take for grazing (16:6).

Surah *An-Nahal* says that you drink the milk of the “أَنْعَامٌ” (*an'aam*) and acquire other benefits from them (23:21). You eat them and also use them for traveling (23:21), make woollen clothes from their wool (16:5), make tents out of their skins (16:80), use them for transferring loads (16:7). They include “حَمُولَةٌ” (*hamulata*) and “فَرْشًا” (*farsha*) as described in (6:143), i.e. those which are used for carrying goods and

those which are too small for this purpose, or are close to the ground. See heading **(H-M-L)**. Verse (43:13) says about the “أَنْعَامٌ” (*an’aam*) that you travel on their backs.

In Surah *Yasin*, all these benefits of the “أَنْعَامٌ” (*an’aam*) have been described together by saying:

37:72	So they ride some of them and eat some of them.	فَمِنْهَا يُرَكِّبُوهُمْ وَمِنْهَا يَأْكُلُونَ وَهُمْ فِيهَا مَنَافِعُ وَمَشَارِبُ
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This verse mentions the benefits from these animals, i.e. about eating them (their flesh), for carrying goods and other benefits.

Surah *An-Nahal* describes the animals which the Arabs used to take out for grazing mornings and evenings (16:6) and the beasts of burden are mentioned separately (16:7).

About the “خَيْلٌ” (*khayal*) (horses), “بِغَالٌ” (*bighaal*) (asses) and the “حَمِيرٌ” (*hameer*) (donkeys) is said:

16:8	They are used for traveling and used for embellishment too	لِتَرْكَبُوا هَا وَرَيْنَهُ
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Surah *Aal-e-Imran* mentions:

3:13	That is marked or cultivated horses and cattle	الْخَيْلِ الْمُسَوَّمَةِ وَالْأَنْعَامِ
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Surah *Al-Mumin* says:

40:79	Allah has created four legged animals for you so that you can ride some of them and some you use for eating (their flesh)	اللَّهُ الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمْ الْأَنْعَامَ لِتَرْكَبُوا مِنْهَا وَمِنْهَا تَأْكُلُونَ
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From these explanations, one can glean that “الْأَنْعَامُ” (*al-in’aam*) means “those animals which graze and their milk is consumed”. They are used for riding and for carrying weights, their wool is use to make woollen cloth, their skins are used for making tents, they are used for embellishment, i.e. for pride, and their flesh is used for eating. These are the things the Arabs of those times used the “الْأَنْعَامُ” (*al-in’aam*) for. Except the ones the Quran has declared as forbidden, all other “أَنْعَامٌ” (*in’aam*) are permitted to be edible. Also see heading **(H-R-M)**.

Na’a m نَعَمٌ

“نَعَمْ” (*na’am*): yes.

“قَالُوا نَعَمْ” (*qaalu na’am*): they said “yes”, this has happened (7:42).

It is a word which is used to agree.

For “نَعِيمٌ” (*ni’im*) and “نَعِيمًا” (*na’imma*), see heading **(N-Ain-M)**.

N-Gh-Zd ن غ ض

“نَغَضَ الشَّيْءَ يَنْغُضُهُ” (*naghazash shaiya yanghazahu*): made something move.

“نَغَضَ الشَّيْءُ” (*naghazash shaiyi*): something moved, became immobile.

“نَغَضَ رَأْسَهُ” (*naghaza raasahu*): he shook his head, moved his head.

Akhdash says that to move shaky means “نَغَضَ” (*naghaz*).

“نَغَضٌ” (*naghzun*): ostrich, because when it moves its head moves a lot {*T, R*}. *Ibn Faris* also says this.

“أَنْغَضَ رَأْسَهُ” (*anaghzun rasahu*) is said when somebody shakes his head in denial. Some say it means to shake one’s head in surprise or in making fun of something {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

17:51	They will shake their heads with alacrity by way of making fun of you (denying what you say)	فَسَيُنْغِضُونَ إِلَيْكَ رُءُوسَهُمْ
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It also means “to shake one’s head in wonder”.

“نَفَثَ” (*nafasa*), “يَنْفُثُ” (*yanfusuu*): to blow with the mouth slowly so that the spit does not flow out.

Ibn Faris says this root means for something little to come out of the mouth with a small sound. If it is more than that then it is called “تَفْلٌ” (*tufli*).

“تَفَثَ الشَّيْءُ فِي الْقَلْبِ” (*tufatash shaiya fil qalb*): to put something (to suggest) quietly in someone’s heart or mind.

“تَفَثَ الشَّيْءُ فِي الْقَلْبِ” (*imra’atun naffaasah*): a sorceress who blows on knots to prepare magical talismans or items {*T, R, M*}.

“نَفَثَ” (*nafs*): to blow on knots, to create a spell, to put something in the heart or mind {*T, R, M*}.

The Quran says:

113:4	From the evil of the blowers in the knots.	مِنْ شَرِّ النَّفَّاثَاتِ فِي الْعُقَدِ
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“عُقَدٌ” (*qadun*): strong knots.

“نَفَّاثَاتٌ” (*naffasaatun*): those people who create doubts in people’s hearts or minds, those which blow on firm intent or weaken them.

Maulana Obaidullah Sindhi says it means those groups who create obstacles in the natural development of men through false propaganda. He has also said any act through which or by which the Arabs’ resolve was weakened was called magic or sorcery {*Al-Muqaam-ul-Mahmood*}.

“نَفَحَ” (*nafhun*): for something to move ahead or to lift {**Ibn Faris**}.

“نَفَحَ الطِّيبُ يَنْفَحُ” (*nafahat tiyyubu yanfahu*): the fragrance or spreading of a fragrance.

“نَفَحَتِ الرِّيحُ” (*nafahatir reeh*): the wind blew.

“رِيحٌ نَفُوحٌ” (*reehun nafuh*): fast moving wind.

“نَفَحَ” (*nafhun*): any cold wind.

“لَفَحَ” (*lafhun*): warm air, hot wind.

“النَّفْحَةُ مِنَ الرِّيحِ” (*nafhatu minar reeh*): a gust of wind.

“نَفْحَةُ الدَّمِ” (*nafhatud dum*): blood which starts flowing the very first time speedily {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

21:46	One phase of the punishment of Allah (a part or a glimpse of it)	نَفْحَةٌ مِنَ الْعَذَابِ
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“نَفَخَ” (*nafakha*), “يَنْفُخُ” (*yanfukhu*): to blow with the mouth.

“نَفَخَ فِي النَّارِ” (*nafakha fin naar*): he blew on the fire {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says “أَنْفُخُوا” (*unfakhu*) which means “to stoke”.

“إِنْتَفَخَ الشَّيْءُ” (*intafakhash shaiyi*): forgot the thing {*T, M*}.

“إِنْتَفَخَ النَّهَارُ” (*intafakhan nahaar*): the day moved ahead or progressed {*R*}.

“النَّفْخَاءُ مِنَ الْأَرْضِ” (*an-nafkha-u minal ard*): high land.

“النَّفْخَاةُ” (*an-nuffakhah*): the stones which are above the surface of the water. It also means bubbles {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says the root means “to swell” and “to rise”.

The Quran says in connection with the creation of man:

32:9	Breathed into him from His spirit	نَفَخَ فِيهِ مِنْ رُوحِهِ
15:29	Breathed into him of My spirit	نَفَخْتُ فِيهِ مِنْ رُوحِي

As has been mentioned under the heading “رُوح” (*rooh*) which means “the power to decide or intend” which is man’s personality, and has only been given to man among all the creatures. Therefore, “نَفَخَ رُوح” (*nafkhi ruhi*) means not just “to blow” but “breathe soul or the forces” in man, through which a man can attain a high place.

In Surah *Aal-e-Imran, Isa* has said to his people that:

3:48	I will grant you an arrangement through which a new life and force will be created within you, through which you will rise in this world.	أَنِّي أَخْلُقُ لَكُمْ مِنَ الطِّينِ كَهَيْئَةِ الطَّيْرِ فَأَنْفُخُ فِيهِ فَيَكُونُ طَيْرًا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ
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The Quran says “نَفَخَ صُور” (*nafkhi suur*) at several places, as has been said under the heading (*Sd-W-R*). It also means a bugle or trumpet which used to be sounded in times of war. This word is also the plural form as per the former meaning “نَفَخَ صُور” (*nafkha suur*) would mean the declaration of war between right and wrong. According to the latter meaning it would mean to impart a new life, to endow with new strengths, which can help attain loftiness (69:14). See heading (*Sd-W-R*).

N-F-D

ن ف د

“نَفَذَ الشَّيْءُ يَنْفَذُ نَفَادًا” (*nafidash shaiy-u yanfidu nafada*): for a thing to be destroyed, to end.

Zamkhashri says the words which have “فاء” (*fa*) in them mean “to end gradually” and “be obliterated”, such as “نَفَذَ” (*nafada*), “نَفَذَ” (*nafaza*), “نَفَرَ” (*nafar*), “نَفَسَ” (*nafasha*), “نَفَضَ” (*nafaza*), “نَفَقَ” (*nafaqa*) etc. {*T, R*}.

“أَنْفَذَ الْقَوْمُ” (*anfadal qaum*): the people’s supplies and wealth ended {*T*}.

The Quran says:

16:96	That which you have will come to an end, and that which Allah possesses will last	مَا عِنْدَكُمْ يَنْفَدُ وَمَا عِنْدَ اللَّهِ بَاقٍ
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This “بَاقٍ” (*baaq*) has been explained at another place, i.e. that which does not end.

N-F-Dh

ن ف ذ

“الْإِنْفَادُ” (*an-nafaaz*): to pierce something, like an arrow pierces its target, even if it comes out very little at the other end.

“طَعَنَ نَافِذَةً” (*tanfatun naafizah*): for the spear to strike piercingly {*T, R*}.

“أَنْفَذَ الْقَوْمُ” (*anfadal qaum*): he entered the group from behind and moving fast ahead of them.

“النَّافِذَةُ” (*an-naafizah*): a ventilator through which wind and light enter a room.

“نَفَذَ الشَّيْءُ” (*nafazash shaiyi*): he tore something up {*T, R*}.

Ibn Faris says the root basically means to pass through something.

The Quran has thrown light on the possibilities of human evolution. Surah *Ar-Rahman* says:

55:33	O group of ins and jinn! If you have the capability to pierce the ends of this earth and the universe (go beyond it) then do so	يٰۤاَيُّهَا الْاِنْسُ وَالْجِنُّ
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“انس” (*ins*) are people who live in the cities and “جن” (*jinn*) are those who live in desolate places (rural dispersed communities)

But remember:

55:33	You cannot do so without sultan (the capability)	لَا تَنْفَعُكُمْ اِلَّا بِسُلْطٰنٍ
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The Quran has said that man can go out of the limits of this physical universe, but he needs to have a certain capability for this which can overcome physical realities. This strength can be had by following the Revelation. Therefore the Quran has called the Revelation as “سُلْطَانٌ” (*sultaan*). See heading (*S-L-Te*). That is, by following the Revelation man can develop the capability to reach the next stages of life and then live forever. At the usual level life is like that of animals but to live on the human level (i.e. on the levels of *momineen*) can make man capable of life beyond the limits of this life and attain the life beyond. Here the meaning of getting beyond the universe does not mean getting out of the physical universe. Man can fly as high as he wants, but he cannot go beyond the realms of his personality and will always remain within the parameters of the human personality: It is impossible for humans to go beyond the limits of this physical universe in this life. It can only be possible after dying and moving on to the life in the hereafter. Those who claim to go beyond this physical universe on the strength of their spiritual powers only think and they do not really do so. You can go anywhere you want in your thoughts because then you do not need any sultan (or capability) to do so. According to the Quran, man can only go beyond this physical universe after death. He can attain eternal life only in the life hereafter.

N-F-R

ن ف ر

“نَفَرًا” (*an-nafar*): to be restless and get up and move from one’s place {*R*}. It also means to separate, to part {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris too says that this word means to part and move away. Therefore it means to ignore something and to part from it.

“نَفَرًا إِلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*nafara ilash shaiyi*): to go towards something speedily {*T, M*}.

“نَفَرَتِ الدَّبَّةُ” (*nafaratid da abbahu*), “اِسْتَنْفَرْتُ” (*astanfarat*): for an animal to be afraid of someone and move away.

“نَفَرْتُهُ” (*naffartuhu*), “اِسْتَنْفَرْتُهُ” (*istanfartuhu*): made him frightened and caused him to go away.

“مُسْتَنْفِرٌ” (*mustanfir*): one who runs away worried or frustrated {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran says:

74:50	The donkeys who balked	حُمُرٌ مُّسْتَنْفِرَةٌ
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“نَفَرُوا لِلْأَمْرِ” (*nafaru lil amr*): they came out for this purpose (4:71) {*T, M, R*}.

“النَّفَرُ” (*an-nafar*): the group which stands to help someone (18:34).

“نَفِيرٌ” (*nafeer*) also means this very thing, as in (17:6) {*T, F*}.

“نُفُورٌ” (*nufur*): to scamper away frightened, to hate (67:21).

“الْمُنَافَرَةُ” (*al-munaafarah*): pride, because people used to say “اَيُّنَا اَعَزُّ نَفَرًا” (*ayyuna a-azzu nafara*) i.e. power gives pride {*T, M*}.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “نَفْسُ” (*nafas*) has many meanings. This word is use to mean the collection of a man’s internal and external characteristics. It also means the force which distinguishes (awareness and feeling). It also means knowledge and the mind {*T, Lissan-ul-Arab*}. It also has similar meanings as of “عَيْنُ الشَّيْءِ” (*ainush shaiyi*), such as “جَاءَ نِي الْمَلِكُ بِنَفْسِهِ” (*ja’al’ni maliku binafsihi*) which means “the king came to me in person”.

It also means greatness, courage, honor, intent and punishment.

“نَفْسُ” (*nafas*) also means comrade or a brother {*T, Lissan-ul-Arab*}. It also means the same blood.

“نِفَاسُ” (*nifaas*): the blood that women bleed after childbirth, as well as the childbirth itself {*T, Lissan-ul-Arab*}. The plural is “أَنْفَاسُ” (*infaas*).

Ibn Faris says it means the exit of soft and light air.

“نَفَسٌ” (*nafas*) also means vastness and broadness and width or expansion. It also means one sip or smoke, and also a long thing.

“نَفِيسٌ” (*nafees*): abundant wealth.

“شَيْءٌ نَفِيسٌ” (*shaiyun nafeesun*): the good things to which man is quickly attracted.

“تَنَفَّسٌ” (*tanaffus*): to breathe.

“تَنَفَّسَ الصُّبْحُ” (*tanaffasus subih*): for the morning to be evident and bright (81:18).

“نَافَسَ” (*naafas*) and “تَنَافَسَ” (*tanaafus*): to excel in some good deed (83:26) {*T, Lissan-ul-Arab*}. It also means “with me”.

Taj-ul-Uroos quotes the example of a verse from Surah *Al-Ma'idah*:

5:116	O my Sustainer! Whatever there is in my heart is known to you, but I do not know what you have in your mind.	تَعْلَمُ مَا فِي نَفْسِي وَلَا أَعْلَمُ مَا فِي نَفْسِكَ
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It also means the punishment for bad deeds, as in:

3:27	And Allah warns you regarding himself.	وَيُحَذِّرُكُمُ اللَّهُ نَفْسَهُ
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This does not mean that God wants you to be frightened of Him or His Personality. This means that God makes you aware of the results of your deeds that will formulate as per the law of requital, without any external intervention. {*T, Lissan-ul-Arab*}.

“أَنْفُسُ” (*anfus*) also means “compatriot” or “brother” as in (2:84), and also one’s “self” as in (2:42). At such places it is used as in English they say “me”, or “yourself” or “himself” etc.

This word has also been used by the Quran to mean “human personality” or “ego”. This meaning requires further explanation.

It will not be an exaggeration if one says that the basis of **Deen** is accepting the existence of a Self. One of the concepts of life is that human life consists merely of the physical life, that man lives as per the physical laws. His body follows these laws, grows according to these laws, and finally dies according to these laws. This means as soon as he stops breathing then he ceases to exist. This is called in modern terms the Materialistic Concept of Life which is e.g. generally what western culture mainly believes in. According to this concept one does not have to have belief in Allah as explained in the Quran, nor will feel the need to acknowledge that Revelation is the word of God. Even if the followers of this concept agree to there being a God, they will acknowledge only that God has created this universe and it is progressing according to His laws, but obviously this sort of belief has no effect on a man’s conduct in this life.

If one man says that this universe has been created by God and another says no, this has all come into being by accident or coincidence then this difference of opinion does not really affect their individual or

collective behaviours. This is why the Quran does not give any credence to these sort of beliefs and does not consider them as a faith which will bring any change in the human Self. See (29:61-64, 23:84-88, 31:25, 39:38, 43:9), etc.

One who says that life ends with death in this world i.e. there is no hereafter, then the criterion for good and evil is also self-made. Good is something that is beneficial to him or which is appreciated by a society, and evil is something which is hurtful to him or which is thought to be execrable by a society. He believes that there is no law above those which he imposes on himself or which are imposed by a society in which he lives. The purpose of his life is the acquisition of personal happiness and nothing else. The Quran calls it a life of an unbeliever.

The Quran says

3:27	Have you wondered about the man whose desires are his Lord (or God)	أَفَرَأَيْتَ مَنِ اتَّخَذَ إِلَهُهُ هُوَ
45:23	And this desires-worship seals his ears and heart and turns him blind	وَحَتَمَ عَلَى سَمْعِهِ وَقَلْبِهِ وَجَعَلَ عَلَى بَصَرِهِ غِشَاوَةً
45:23	And the man who reaches this stage cannot be guided to the right path but by Allah's guidance: so don't you learn a lesson by viewing the condition of such people	فَمَنْ يَهْدِيهِ مِنْ بَعْدِ اللَّهِ أَفَلَا تَذَكَّرُونَ
45:24	These are the people who say life is confined to this world only: and time alone causes our death (ultimately): or we live and die according to the physical laws:	وَقَالُوا مَا هِيَ إِلَّا أَحْيَا تَنَا الدُّنْيَا نَمُوتُ وَنَحْيَا وَمَا يُهْلِكُنَا إِلَّا الدَّهْرُ
45:24	They are unaware of realities : they only guess that this is their concept of life	وَمَا لَهُمْ بِذَلِكَ مِنْ عِلْمٍ إِنْ هُمْ إِلَّا يَظُنُّونَ

Quran calls this sort of life at an animal level:

47:12	Those who reject a higher form of life, eat and drink and benefit from other things of life like animals and then die	وَالَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا يَتَمَتَّعُونَ وَيَأْكُلُونَ كَمَا تَأْكُلُ الْأَنْعَامُ
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Conversely the other concept of life is that life is not just this physical existence, and that there is another thing beside the human body which is called its Self (consisting of strong sense of identity called 'I', ability to think about thinking, emotions, and memory) or "نَفْسٌ" (*nafas*). It is not governed by physical laws and does not end with death. For example in (23:14) the Quran declares, 'We created out of it another creation' – human Self emerged with the ability to make choices. This is which is addressed by the Quran from the beginning to the end. This lives even after physical death. If lived within the domain of the permanent values, human life can develop the ability to evolve to the other stages of life. Human Self is developed according to the guidance given by God through the messengers and which is now detailed in the Quran. This means that the Quran deals with the issues of the human Self-development or deals with the human thinking. Thus it is seen that the belief in human Self is compatible only with the belief in God, Revelation, messenger-hood and life after death – as this is what is required to bring change in human behaviour which helps to develop inner Self which will bring change in this life and will have the ability to.

What is a human personality? It is not possible to explain, because it is non physical i.e. non visible. Human personality can be gleaned by its attribute of possessing a free will and through its use. Thus we can say that personality contains an ability to choose and is not material. The infinite free will and the ability to choose belong to Allah alone and has been bestowed to a limited extent to man by Him. That is why God has called it "روحنا" (*rouhana*), i.e. "Divine Energy". See heading (**R-W-H**). If man follows Allah's guidance as preserved in the Quran then to a certain extent Allah's attributes are reflected in him. This is what development of the human personality means. It must be noted here that the human personality is not a part of Allahs' personality. Personality, whether it be of God or man is an indivisible whole which cannot be divided into parts.

Since every one of man's deeds is based upon his intent, therefore, his every deed affects his personality, even the thoughts which pass through his mind (40:19). This is what constitutes his accountability details of which hang around his neck as per the Quran (17:13).

It will be read by him at the time of the manifestation of result (as to what has he been doing):

17:14	Read your book (results), your own self is enough to hold you accountable by seeing the results	اقْرَأْ كِتَابَكَ كَفَىٰ بِنَفْسِكَ الْيَوْمَ عَلَيْكَ حَسِيبًا
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See also (75:15).

This proves the individuality of a human being's personae (that it is not dependant on any other thing) (19:95, 6:95), i.e. every human act affects man's own personality and no one else's. No other can be a partner to it.

6:165	Every individual has to be accountable for his own deeds and no bearer of burdens can bear other's burden	وَلَا تَكْسِبُ كُلُّ نَفْسٍ إِلَّا عَلَيْهَا وَلَا تَزُولُ مِنْهُ وَزْرٌ أُخْرَىٰ
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In this context the following verses can also be referred (6:105), (10:108), (17:7), (17:15), (27:92), (29:6), (30:44), (31:12), (35:18), (39:41), (41:46), (45:15), (35:18), (39:7), (53:38).

When the human personality is developed by following the Quran, then it develops the ability to reach the next evolutionary stages of life and this is called the life of *jannat* or heaven. But the personality which does not develop becomes stagnant and its development stops. This is the life of *jahannam* or *jaheem*. See heading (*J-N-N*, (*J-H-M*) and *Jahannam*.

Generally following the values contained in the Quran is required (and this can be done by being a part of the Quranic society) but in this context the Quran has mentioned a point which is very important. A man's body is nurtured by everything he eats or takes in. The development of human personality takes place by all good we do for others.

92:16	He who gives whatever he has or his wealth for the development of others is protected from <i>jahannam</i>	وَسَيُجَنَّبُهَا الْأَتْقَى - الَّذِي يُؤْتِي مَالَهُ يَتَزَكَّى
92:6	He who gives and attains <i>taqwa</i>	مَنْ أَعْطَىٰ وَاتَّقَىٰ

Also see (59:9), (64:16).

Human Self is a potential, ability, a possible force which is neither good nor bad in itself – our inner thought process gives us the ability to think, evaluate and then make decisions. Whatever we think and do goes into our memory and contribute to our self-concept. The way we make decisions using our thinking process makes it good or bad i.e. the consequences of our thinking and deeds. When man uses it for the higher ideals of life within the permanent values of the Quran, it becomes the instrument of good, and this nurtures a man's own Self. And when man uses this force for selfish ends or evil purposes then it turns bad or evil. In this connection to make distinction between bad and good the human Self which follows bad is called "ego" i.e. when it does bad and this occurs at an animal level and the Self related to good occurs at a human level.

When human emotions follow the ego, the Quran calls such behaviour as '*hawa*'. This root has the connotation of lowliness. See heading (*H-W-Y*). And when intellect serves the ego, it is called deception and intrigue.. When emotions and intellect remain subservient to the human Self within the permanent values, these become the highest forms of humanity, and the human society becomes a model of heavenly life as detailed in the Quran.

When ego pushes back some permanent value and goes for some lowly benefit, it is called in the Quran as (*nafasi ammara*).

This term has been borrowed from the Quranic verse where this saying of the wife of the minister of Egypt has been quoted that:

12:53	Verily <i>nafas</i> keeps tempting to do wrong (base desires)	إِنَّ النَّفْسَ لَأَمَّارَةٌ بِالسُّوءِ
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This does not mean that *nafas* is completely bad, not at all. This is being said about the ego. After that it is said:

12:53	Excepting the one on whom God is merciful (who enjoys the kindness of God)	إِلَّا مَرْحَمَ رَبِّي
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This is the level of *nafas* that we term as “human Self”.

Sometimes the human *nafas* feels ashamed of doing something. This is in fact a struggle between the ego and the Self. It has been called “نفس لوامه” (*nafasi lawwama*) by the Quran in (75:2), i.e. the *nafas* that scorns (feeling guilt at doing something). Here it must be understood that the human personality does not have the ability to differentiate between good and evil. This can only be done with the help of the revelation as an external standard. We do not have inner guidance due to the ability to make choices. “نفس لوامه” (*nafasi lawwama*) can only admonish for what it thinks is execrable, but it is not necessary that which it thinks to be bad is in fact bad, and that which it considers commendable is truly commendable – as there is nothing within us which can help us to make a decision. For details see heading (*L-H-M*) and (*F-T-R*).

When man follows strictly the permanent values of the Quran then the struggle between the ego and the Self ends. The developed Self overcomes the lowly emotions by recognising them and then over ruling these temptations using the criterion provided by the permanent values of the Quran (39:29) – this makes it necessary to know the permanent values of the Quran which must be in the human memory (If these are not in our memory we cannot use these values). This has been termed by the Quran as “نفس مطمئنه” (*nafas mutma-innah*) in (89:27) – using these values as an external standard one can then evaluate own contact as detailed in the Quran. A life being lived within these permanent values is termed heavenly or jannah (89:29). In modern language the developed Self using the permanent values as a criterion and with the concept of Allah as a model, will be called an integrated Self – such Self will be free from the inner confusion of multi Self problems. Against this will be the disintegrated Self called Ego. These two conditions of the *nafas* have been called by the Quran as “فُجُورًا وَتَقْوَاً” (*fujuruha wa taqwaha*) in (91:8-10). For details see heading (*L-H-M*). The Quran terms the development of the Self as the purpose of life and its success and fulfilment is the reason for the creation of the heavens and the earth (45:22).

Since human personality is given to every new born equally, therefore every human being is respectable for being born with it. At the Self level all human beings are equal and all the visible universe including this world is for this Self.

17:70	We have created every human being as respectable	وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ
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This means that no man should be subjugated by another human being. The attribute of free will (the freedom to choose) is a permanent value and is a basic human characteristic. Therefore to usurp someone’s freedom to choose is slavery which is the same as depriving him of human respect. The creation of the conditions on the planet which curtails human freedom to do good is against the Quran and is equivalent of setting up other gods. The Quran says that man should only be subservient to its permanent values which will give him the true freedom – the freedom available within the domain of the permanent values procides infinite thinking ability and choices at the Self level. This is what true ‘worship’ is. See heading (*Ain-B-D*). This obedience is not the obedience imposed externally by some oppressive ruler or of man made laws. A man accepts to work within these permanent values to help own self-development after using his intellect and reasoning and by carrying out a comparison with the relative values and then accepting the permanent values as a better option. It means to impose some limitation with the willingness of the heart, and it is imposed for self-discipline and for the development of the Self as this leads to change in behaviour with a view to work for the good of mankind on a universal basis.

2:286	This very thing i.e. the limits imposed by the revelation develops his Self and does not curb his freedom	لَا يَكْتُلُ اللَّهُ نَفْسًا إِنْ أُوتِهَا
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See heading (K-L-F).

A Quranic system creates a society in which nobody is subservient to anybody and human Self is not bound by any constraints and its thinking perspective changes to universal level. Thus a man gets heavenly life in this world as well as in the life hereafter.

Regarding the phenomena of sleep the Surah *Az-Zumr* says:

39:42	Allah suspends the <i>nafas</i> in death and in those who are not dead but are sleeping makes the <i>nafas</i> so, and for those whom the time for death has come holds the <i>nafas</i> back and for those who are to live for a fixed time sends the <i>nafas</i> back	اللَّهُ يَتَوَفَّى الْأَنْفُسَ حِينَ مَوْتِهَا وَالَّتِي لَمْ تَمُتْ فِي مَنَامِهَا فَيُمْسِكُ الَّتِي قَضَىٰ عَلَيْهَا الْمَوْتَ وَيُرْسِلُ الْأُخْرَىٰ إِلَىٰ أَجَلٍ مُّسَمًّى
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What does *nafas* in this verse means, which is suspended in death and in sleep but if the man is not dead and awakens from slumber, it is sent back or restored? In the case of death it is not sent back. As far as sleep is concerned we know that everything is present except the consciousness during sleep. So much so that even the sub-consciousness is also present in sleep. Therefore obviously *nafas* is the conscious state as both in death and sleep a man's consciousness is taken away. When the sleeper awakens then his consciousness starts working again. Consciousness to work again after death is called the life hereafter.

At the present level of our knowledge we cannot say how consciousness works, because at this point of time our consciousness is activated only through our bodies. At this point of time we cannot even conceive of consciousness out of our bodies. The Quran has not clarified as to how consciousness works in the life hereafter, nor is there any cause or benefit for doing so because there is no point in explaining or stating a thing which we cannot comprehend at our present level of intellect and consciousness. But still it mentions consciousness after death as a veritable reality. This area requires further research in the field of human psychology from the Quranic perspective e.g. looking at the physical self from the developed human Self's perspective.

N-F-Sh

ن ف ش

“نَفْسٌ” (*nafsh*): to soil the wool or cotton with the fingers. Some say that “نَفْسٌ” (*nafsh*) means for every such thing to be scattered for which it is easy to scatter, for example cotton, wool etc. {T, R}.

The Quran says:

101:6	coloured wool that has been beaten (or scattered or taken apart)	الْعِهْنِ الْمَنْفُوشِ
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Ibnul Sakeet says “نَفْسٌ” (*nafshun*) means for goats or camels to go away hither and thither without the knowledge of the shepherd at night.

“نَفْسٌ” (*nafshun*) is particularly at night, but “بَمْلَمٌ” (*hamlun*) does not have to be at night.

The Quran says:

21:78	When people's flock of goats scattered at night while grazing	إِذْ نَفَشْتِ فِيهِ عَنَمَ الْقَوْمِ
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“النَّفْعُ” (*an-naf'u*): the opposite of loss.

“نَفْعٌ” (*naf'u*): through which some pleasantness is reached $\{T\}$. Everyone knows how a shepherd's staff is used to make the herd reach pleasantness, hence his staff is also called “النَّفْعَةُ” (*naf'u*).

The Quran has used this word against “ضَرَرٌ” (*zarar*) which means “loss” (2:102), and also against “إِثْمٌ” (*ismun*) in 2:219. As such “نَفْعٌ” (*nafhun*) would mean both internal and external benefits.

“مَنَافِعُ” (*manafi'u*): benefits or useful things, as in 2:219. Singular form is “مَنْفَعَةٌ” (*manfa'ah*).

“نَفَقٌ” (*nafqun*): a tunnel with both ends open.

“سَرَبٌ” (*sarab*): a tunnel which has no exit.

“النَّفَقَةُ” (*an-nufqah*) and “النَّفَقَاءُ” (*an-nafiqah*): one of the holes from among many of a desert wild rat, at the mouth of which is a thin film of mud, and which is opened by striking its head against it when some adversary is after it in the tunnel.

“نَيْفَقٌ” (*neefaq*), “نَيْفَةٌ” (*nifa*): the tunnel of cloth through which the waist band passes with both ends open. Some think that it has been derived into Arabic from the word “نَيْفَةٌ” (*neefah*).

“مُنَافِقٌ” (*munafiq*): a person who ensures that there is a way out before entering some society or group.

“نَفَقَتِ السُّوقُ” (*nafawatis suuq*): the market warmed up, and there was demand for goods, i.e. which is always open for import and export of goods, or which is always open for the coming and going of goods.

“إِنْفَاقٌ” (*infaaq*): keep one's wealth open, to make it available, not to hold on to it $\{T, F\}$.

The Quran has made its meaning clear in (17:100) by bringing “إِمْسَاكٌ” (*imsaak*) which means “to preserve” against it.

“نَفَاقٌ” (*nafaaq*): to decrease, or to end, since keeping one's wealth open is the negation of capital $\{T, F\}$.

“انْفَقَتِ الْإِبِلُ” (*anfaqatil ibl*): when the wool of a camel falls off due to plumpness, i.e. is scattered and dirtied and is wasted $\{T, F\}$.

The Quran says “إِنْفَاقٌ” (*infaaq*) to basically mean “to keep the fruits of one's labour open or available for mankind”:

2:219	They ask you how much wealth they should keep available (for the sustenance of others). Tell them “all that is beyond your needs”	وَيَسْأَلُونَكَ مَاذَا يُنْفِقُونَ قُلِ الْغِنَى
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Surplus money which is the basis of capitalism should be left open for others use, and should be available for the sustenance of mankind. It should not stay in some individual's ownership.

This is Quran's basic point and is a permanent value. A *momin's* earning has both ends open and this earning is in the hands of the Quranic system i.e. in control of the system. Every individual contributes to this according to his earnings and the Islamic system spends from it for the benefit of mankind. Since the responsibility for looking after the needs of the individuals is on this system, therefore no one need keep any surplus money with him. Neither does he need to have any worry about his own future or that of his children. All these responsibilities lie with the system which is set up according to the Quranic values.

At these places “إِنْفَاقٌ” (*infaaq*) would mean to keep open rather than to spend. “To keep open” would mean “to keep in the custody of the Islamic system for mankind's sustenance”.

“نَفَاقٌ” (*nafaqah*): anything that is kept open in this way (9:121). At some places though, “إِنْفَاقٌ” (*infaaq*) would mean “to spend”.

“نَافِقٌ” (*naafiq*): to be a hypocrite (3:166). Hypocrites are most dangerous for a society. On one hand there are those who with full leaning of their hearts adhere to the system of Allah. These are called *momins*. On the other hand there are those who openly reject this system and stay out of it. They are called *kaafirs*. The third group is of those who join the *momins* due to some exigencies. They stay with the *momins* as long as there is some benefit in doing so, and part with them whenever there is the slightest chance of some trial or loss, or spread disenchantment or chaos within the group. These are called *munafiq* and are the worst of creatures. That is why the Quran says they will be in the lowest part of the *jahannam* (4:145). After the Surah *Al-Fatiha* (which is the first Surah of the Quran) the Quran has mentioned these three groups of people (i.e. *momins*, *kaafirs* and the *munafiqs*). Thereafter these groups are discussed in many verses of the Quran. These groups were not confined to those times only, but these will always be there in a society as they have always been. For further details see relevant headings.

N-F-L

ن ف ل

“النَّفْلُ” (*an-nafl*): every act that is more or addition to the mandatory.
 “النَّفَالُ” (*an-nafal*): spoils of war, share, gift. The plural of both is “أَنْفَالٌ” (*anfaal*).
 “نَافِلَةٌ” (*naafilah*): the same as “نَفْلٌ” (*nafl*).

The Quran says:

17:79	Get up at some part of the night (to recite the Quran)	وَمِنَ اللَّيْلِ فَتَهَجَّدْ بِهِ نَافِلَةً لَكَ
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This is “نفل” (*nafl*) for you

“النَّافِلَةُ” (*an-naafilah*): paternal grandson, because the son is the real thing and grandson is additional (21:72).
 “أَنْفَالٌ” (*un-faal*): some think it means the spoils of war and some think that it is other than that (8:1).

Ordinarily it is taken to mean “spoils of war”, or “share” or “gift” {T}, but I think that it need not be linked with war only. It can mean all the income of the state which is over that which is due to it (in the shape of taxes etc).

“النَّوْفَلُ” (*un-naufal*): river, sea, gift, a man who is a great philanthropist {T}.
 “نَفَلَ فُلَانًا” (*nafala fulaana*): gave something to that man as a gift for which no return was sought {T}

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is “to give something as a gift” as well as “gift” itself.

N-F-Y

ن ف ي

“نَفَى” (*nafa*), “يَنْفِي” (*yanfi*), “نَفَيْتُ” (*nafiyta*): to put to one side, to extract, to separate, to remove {T}.

Ibn Faris says it means to remove something from another thing.

“النَّفْيُ” (*an-nafiyu*): that which comes out of a pot as it comes to boil, like the pebbles etc. which are pushed to one side at the feet when the animals move or walk. It also means the dirt which the winds lay at the bottom of trees. It also means a part of an army which gets separated from the main body.
 “نَفَى شَعْرُ فُلَانٍ” (*nafa sherun fulaan*): that man’s hair was dishevelled, or fell off.
 “نَفَى السَّيْلُ الْغُشَاءَ” (*nafas sailul ghusha’a*): the flood took away the garbage etc.
 “نَفَى” (*nafa*): to deny, refuse.
 “نَفَى الْأَبُ الْإِبْنَ” (*nafal abul ibn*): the father refused to acknowledge the son as his own {T}.

In traditional sense the Quran says that those who try to disrupt the system of Allah or create chaos in it, should be killed, or hung, or cut their hands or feet. See heading (*Q-Th-Ain*). But according to the above given meaning of “نَفَى” (*nafyu*), such verses are talking about exile, not killing (5:33).

Muheet says that “نَفَىٰ فُلَانًا” (*nafa fulaan*) also means to imprison someone {*T*}.

With the addition of “مِنَ الْأَرْضِ” (*min-al-ard*) it would mean “exile” or “to make devoid of freedom and other benefits”. Thus removing someone from the earth would mean to separate him from the rest of the population, not to kill him.

N-Q-B

ن ق ب

“نَقَبَ” (*naqab*): to drill an opening in the wall: and the opening itself too {*T*}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:67	they could not drill holes in the wall	وَمَا اسْتَطَاعُوا لَهُ نَقْبًا
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“تَنْقَبُ عَنِ السَّيِّئِ” (*tanaqqaba unish shaiyi*): to strive in search of something, wander everywhere in search of something {*M*}.

Surah *Al-Qaf* says:

50:26	They searched the cities in search of some sanctuary	فَتَنَقَّبُوا فِي الْبِلَادِ
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Ibn Faris says “نَقَبَ” (*naqqaba*) means to move in the narrow paths or passes between the mountains.

“النَّقِيبُ” (*an-naqeeb*): a flute, because of its holes.

“النَّقِيبُ” (*an-naqqeebu*): the watchman of the nation, guarantor, leader, someone who keeps himself aware of the conditions of the people, someone who investigates {*T*}.

About the *Bani Israel* it is said:

5:12	We appointed 12 leaders from among them	وَبَعَثْنَا مِنْهُمُ اثْنَيْ عَشَرَ نَقِيبًا
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“النَّقْبَةُ” (*an-nuqbah*): hole. It also means face, perhaps because it has many holes.

“النَّقَابُ” (*an-niqaab*): the mask that a woman wears to hide her face.

“النَّقَابُ” (*al-munqabah*): matter of pride, high achievements, quality, good trait {*T*}.

N-Q-Dh

ن ق ذ

“نَفَذَهُ” (*nafazahu*), “أَنْقَذَهُ” (*anqazahu*), “أَسْتَنْقَذَهُ” (*astanqazahu*): to liberate him, free him, to get rid of him.

“نَفَذَ الرَّجُلُ” (*naqazar rajul*): the man was liberated and was safe {*T, M*}.

Raghib says this word is used to be rid of some great misery or difficulty.

“نَقَذَ لَكَ” (*naqzan lak*) is said when a person slips or commits an error, i.e. “may Allah keep you safe from harm”.

“النَّقِذَةُ” (*an-naqeezah*): the horse that is liberated from an enemy {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

3:102	Then He saved you from that.	فَأَنقَذَكُم مِّنْهَا
22:73	He did not manage to free him of that	لَا يَسْتَنْقِذُوهُ مِنْهُ

“تَقْرَهُ” (*naqarah*), “تَقْرَأُ” (*naqra*): hit him with a “مِنْقَارٌ” (*minqaar*) – for meaning see below.
 “الْتَقَرُّ” (*an-naqr*): to work a slab or grind a wheel.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to hit a thing on the head so that it causes holes or ditches to appear on that which is stroked. Later this word acquired greater meaning.

“الْمِنْقَارُ” (*al-minqaar*) is the instrument which is held while grinding a wheel. It also means “the beak of a bird” since when beak strikes something it produces the sound of “*khat, khat*”. Hence this word came to mean “sound”, especially a sound in which the tongue sticks to the base of the mouth. This sound is used to spur a horse onwards, or the sound of the fingers (snap).

“النَّقِيرُ” (*an-naqeer*): a sound like a whistle {*T*}.

Lissan-ul-Arab says that “نَاقُورٌ” (*naaqur*) means “bugle”.

The Quran says:

74:8	When war will be announced (declared) against the rebellious forces	فَإِذَا تُنْفِرُ الْغَافِقُونَ
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“الْغَفَارَةُ” (*an-nuqaarah*): that little thing which a bird can pick up in its beak {*T*}.

“النَّقِيرُ” (*an-naqeer*): the small point that appears on the back of the seed of a date {*T*}. It actually means a small and insignificant thing.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:53	They will give nothing to people	لَا يُؤْتُونَ النَّاسَ نَقِيرًا
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Ibn Qataa says that “نَقَصٌ” (*naqsun*) means for something to complete and then for something from it to decrease.

“النَّقْصُ” (*an-naqs*): for the share to decrease.

“النَّقْصَانُ” (*an-nuqsaan*): the amount that is decreased from a thing.

“النَّقِيبَةُ” (*an-naqeesatuh*): fault {*T*}.

“تَنَاقَسَ الشَّيْءُ” (*tanaqasash shaiyi*): the thing decreased gradually {*M*}.

“نَقَصَ” (*naqas*), “يَنْقُصُ” (*yanqus*): decreased it, decreased. It appears both as transitive and intransitive verb.

The Quran says:

2:155	For wealth to decrease	نَقْصٍ مِنَ الْأَمْوَالِ
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One of the losses a *momin* group faces in establishing Allah’s system is also the loss of wealth, but after this system is established all sorts of abundance accrue to the group. If some other system results in the lessening of sustenance then that decrease is *Pharaonic* and punishment from Allah (7:130). To face difficulties in establishing an Islamic system is to be understood in the context of the Quranic guidance. The results of the Quranic system are visibly good event though the opponents create a lot of expected difficulties. These difficulties can include the loss of material and wealth.

“نَقَضَ” (*naaz*): to cover, to break, to open, to break an agreement {T}.

“النَّقِصُ” (*an-niqz*): a destroyed building or its ruins. It also means a camel that has become weak due to traveling constantly.

“النَّقِيزُ” (*an-naqeez*): the sound of a person’s joints {T}.

“الَّذِي أَنْقَضَ ظَهْرَكَ” (*al-lazi anqaza zarak*): the burden (responsibility) which broke your back (94:3).

“تَنَاقُضٌ” (*tanaquz*): the opposite of “نَقَضَ” (*naqaz*) which means “each other’s opposition” i.e. “where one thing refutes the other”.

The Quran has generally used the word “نَقَضَ” (*naqaz*) to mean “breach of agreement” as in (61:91), (2:27).

“نَقَضَتْ غَزْلَهَا” (*naqazat ghazlaha*): broke the thread into pieces, or unwind it (16:92).

N-Q-Ain

ن ق ع

“النَّقْعُ” (*an-naq’u*): good land with pure soil in which water accumulates, or the water that accumulates somewhere, or the dust that rises {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for some liquid to stop (accumulate) at one place, and a type of sound.

This word has many other meanings too, but the Quran uses it to mean “raise dust” as in:

100:4	the horses of the challenging party which enter the ranks of the enemy raising dust with their hooves	فَأَنزَلْنَا بِهِ نَقْعًا
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N-Q-M

ن ق م

“النَّقَمُ” (*an-naqam*): the middle of a way, the middle portion of a path {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says this root means to declare something as unfavourable and think it to be faulty.

“الْإِنْتِقَامُ” (*intiqam*) would mean to “call a spade a spade” and take revenge on someone who does bad.

“النَّقْمَةُ” (*an-niqmah*): to punish a crime {T, R}. This is what “the Law of requital” is i.e. “tit for tat”.

Allah has been called “زُنْتُقَامًا” (*zuntiqam*) in (3:4). He is the one according to whose laws the good deeds are rewarded and bad deeds get punished. We use the word “outcome” quite differently, therefore while using the word for Allah we should not attribute the usual meanings of “revenge” to it, but rather the natural turn of events.

Surah *Al-Airaff* says about the nation of the Pharaoh:

7:136	We punished them for their wrong doings	فَأَنقَمْنَا مِنْهُمْ
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Surah *Al-Sajdah* says:

32:22	we give the criminals the return for their deeds	إِنَّا مِنَ الْمُجْرِمِينَ مَنصِقِمُونَ
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“نَقَمَ” (*naqam*): to dislike something, some matter, to think bad about it, to criticize it (5:59).

Surah *Al-Buruj* says:

85:8	And these unbelievers dislike the believers because the latter believe in Allah. (they think bad about their being believers)	وَمَا نَقَمُوا مِنْهُمْ إِلَّا أَن يُؤْمِنُوا بِاللَّهِ
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“تَكْب عَنْهُ” (*nakaba unhu*), “يَنْكُبُ” (*yunkubu*), “نَكِبَ” (*nakiba*) and “يَنْكَبُ” (*yankab*): to move away, the path that moves away from the real destination, not to stay in the right direction.
 “طَرِيقُ يَنْكُوبُ” (*tareequn yankuub*): the path that is different from that of the real destination.
 “الْكَبَاءُ” (*annakba’oo*): every wind that blows away from its (right) direction {*T, R, F*}.
 “الْمَنْكِبُ” (*al-mankibu*): the corner of anything, plus the shoulder.
 “مَنَاكِبُ الْأَرْضِ” (*manakibul arz*): the curve of the land {*T, R*}

The Quran says:

23:74	they have moved away from the right path	عَنِ الصِّرَاطِ لَنَّاكِبُونَ
67:15	move around in its environs	فَأَمْشُوا فِي مَنَاكِبِهَا

Some have translated it to mean “mountains” because “الْأَنْكَبُ” (*al-ankabu*) is said about a person whose one shoulder is higher than the other {*M*}.

“النَّكْتُ” (*an-niksu*): old blankets or warm clothes which are unwoven so that they can be knit again.
 “نَكَثَ الْعَهْدَ” (*nakasal ahd*): broke the pact.
 “نَكَثَ الْحَبْلَ” (*nakasal habl*): untied the rope.
 “النَّكِيَّةُ” (*an-nakisatu*): reneging on a promise. It also means the weave of a rope {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “to break a thing”.

The Quran says:

7:135	they break Pacts or promises	إِذَا هُمْ يَنْكُتُونَ
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“أَنْكَاتًا” (*ankaasa*): pieces or tufts of unwoven wool (16:94).

“نِكَاحُ” (*nikah*): to gather and make to meet {*M*}, but “make meet” in the way “the eyes meet sleep”. As such it is said “نَكَحَ النَّعَاسُ” (*nakahun na’aas*) which means “sleep intermingled with his eyes” or the way in which raindrops get absorbed in the ground.
 “نَكَحَ الْمَطَرُ الْأَرْضَ” (*nakaha matarul arza*): the rain water was well absorbed by the ground;

This is said when the rain water passes through the dry exterior and reaches the land’s interior which is soft and damp {*T*}.

These examples illustrate what the Quran designates as a family matter between man and wife through wedlock which is called “نِكَاحُ” (*nikah*). It means that a relationship between a husband and wife should be like the relationship of eyes and sleep. Husband and wife should figuratively be absorbed into each other as sleep gets absorbed by the eyes, or the way in which the rain water is absorbed by the ground. This sort of relationship can last a lifetime only if the couple’s values and beliefs are the same and their way of thinking is alike. This is the basic condition for a successful “نِكَاحُ” (*nikah*). For details see the book titled “*Letters to Tahira*”.

It is obvious that mutual consent is necessary for such a relationship, and the Quran has also explained that mutual consent is necessary (4:3, 4:19). Mutual consent between a pair can only be possible when the

husband and wife are adults. In verse (4:6) it has been explained by saying “بَلَّغُوا النِّكَاحَ” (*balughun nikah*) which means “mature matrimony”.

In verse (17:35) and (6:153) this has been explained as “حَتَّى يَبْلُغَ أَشُدَّهُ” (*hatta yablughu ashaddahu*), and “أَشُدَّهُ” (*ashaddahu*) has been explained as the age between childhood and old age i.e. “adulthood” (40:67). Therefore the question of someone getting married before adult age does not arise, nor can anyone else’s consent on behalf of a girl or a boy can be considered.

Raghib has said that the word “نِكَاحٌ” (*nikah*) appears for “wedlock”, and for “coupling” the word is used only as a metaphor.

The Quran says:

2:235	The knot of <i>nikah</i> (wedlock)	
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Surah *Al-Yajidun* says:

24:33	the arrangements for wedlock or the goods of <i>nikah</i>	
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It can also mean “relationship” and also “those expenses that are necessary for a household”.

It also means the gift money for a wife. As far as the expenses of wedlock are concerned, they are merely a custom and not a requirement.

According to the Quran, “نِكَاحٌ” (*nikah*) is the agreement between two adults, a man and a woman of good sense, that they will live together to fulfill all the rights and responsibilities as defined by the Quran. For this the Quran has neither reserved any custom nor ceremony. Customs and traditions are only a man made social requirement, however in order to avoid later complexities that may arise, it is necessary for this pact of “نِكَاحٌ” (*nikah*) to have witnesses and a formal social registration.

N-K-D ن ك د

“نَكِدَ عَيْشُهُ” (*nakidah eeshuhu*): his life became hard and narrow or difficult.

“نَكِدَتِ الْبَيْرُ” (*nakidatu bish*): water of a well diminished.

“النُّكْدُ” (*un-nukdu*): the she camels whose kids are dead {*T*}, or who can be milked with difficulty only {*R*}.

The basic meanings of this word are “lessening” as well as “hardship”.

Ibn Faris says it means “to get one’s demands after hard labour”.

“نَاقَةٌ نَكْدَاءُ” (*naqatun nukda’o*): a she camel who has no milk.

“أَرْضُونَ نِكَادُ” (*arazuna nikadun*): lands with very little produce {*R*}.

The Quran says:

7:58	bad lands produce very little (they require much labour and produce very little)	وَالَّذِي خُبْتُ لَا يُخْرِجُ إِلَّا نَكْدًا
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N-K-R ن ك ر

“النَّكْرُ” (*un-nakru*) or “النُّكْرُ” (*un-nukr*): excessive cleverness, the deceit of the intellect.

“رَجُلٌ نَكِيرٌ” (*rajulun nakiroon*): a very clever man.

“الْمُنَاكَرَةُ” (*al-munakaratu*): to deceive one another {*T*}.

The Quran says:

29:48	Verily <i>as-salaat</i> prevents from dirty and bad things (it stops from doing any deed that has negative consequences)	إِنَّ الصَّلَاةَ تَنْهَى عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَالْمُنْكَرِ
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“فَحْشَاءُ” (*fahsha'o*) also means “stinginess”. See heading (*F-H-Sh*).

“مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) means “the deceit of one’s own intellect which advises it to look after its own interests only” i.e. “to be selfish and let others fend for themselves”.

These meaning are made clearer by the verses (70:23-24) where it is said that if man is left to own intellect and desires only, i.e. without the revelation, then his condition is such that in pain or difficulty, he cries out and in good stead becomes stingy.

But this is not the state of the *musalleen* i.e. of the people who always hold themselves accountable before Allah and follow the system of *salaat* - there is a known share in their income for the needy and the deprived and those who ask for. This fact is known to others as well.

“تَكْرُ الْأَمْرِ” (*nakural amru*): the matter became difficult.

“الْتَكْرَاءُ” (*an-nukra'oo*): misery and hardship.

“تَكْرَاءُ الدَّيْرِ” (*nakra'ood dahr*): the miseries of the time and harshness {T}.

The Quran says:

18:87	strong punishment which they would not have seen before	عَذَابًا نُّكَرًا
54:6	a very miserable thing	شَيْءٌ نُّكْرٍ

“نُكْرٌ” (*nukroon*): a thing which is not of good tiding, that which the heart does not accept, that which is displeasing {Ibn Faris}.

This word has appeared against “فَرَحٌ” (*farahoon*) which means “happiness” (13:36).

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:74	you have done a very displeasing thing	لَقَدْ جِئْتَ شَيْئًا نُّكَرًا
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“أَنْكُرٌ” (*ankuur*): very displeasing (31:19).

“النَّكِيرُ” (*un-nakeer*): refusal {T}.

Surah *Ash-Shura* says:

42:47	You will not be able to refuse	مَا لَكُمْ مِنْ نَكِيرٍ
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It also means “the punishment for going against the truth” i.e. destruction.

“تَكْيِيرٌ” (*nakeer*) also means “to change something which seems bad” {T}.

22:44	So how was My punishment? (how was My reaction to their bad deeds?)	فَكَيْفَ كَانَ نَكِيرِ
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“النَّكْرَةُ” (*un-nakratu*): not to recognize something.

“الْإِنْكَارُ” (*al-inkaar*): the opposite of “عِرْفَانٌ” (*irfanun*), i.e. “not to recognize” is the opposite of being “familiar”.

Surah Yusuf says:

12:58	Yusuf recognized them (his brothers) but they were not recognizing him	فَعَرَفْتَهُمْ وَهُمْ لَهُ مُنْكَرُونَ
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Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:70	he thought of them as strangers (he expressed surprise at them)	نَكِرَهُمْ
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Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

5:62	unknown people or strange people	قَوْمٌ نَّكَرُونَ
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“نَكَرَ” (*nakkara*): to change something in a way that it cannot be recognized as its former self (27:41) {*T, R, Ibn Qateebah*}.

The Quran has mentioned “أَمْرٌ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ” (*amri bil'maroof*) and “نَهْيٌ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ” (*nahi unil munkar*) quite often as in (3:103). The right meaning of these words i.e. “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*maroof*) and “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) has been detailed under heading (*Ain-R-F*). In short a Quranic or Islamic society formulates laws and rules under the permanent values of the Quran for its society.

These are called “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*maroof*), i.e. “recognized as acceptable by that society”. Things which are not acceptable to this society are called “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*). These two words describe all acceptable, favourable, pleasant and unpleasant things or deeds.

The concept that “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*maroof*) means “all those things and deeds which are natural” and “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) are “all those things which are unnatural” is not a Quranic concept. There is nothing within man which can differentiate at its own between right and wrong. If there was something in him like the instinct within animals then there was no need of the revelation at all. See heading (*F-Te-R*) and (*L-H-M*).

“مَعْرُوفٌ” (*maroof*) is that which is acceptable and “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) is something which is not pleasant according to the revelation. These include governmental laws and rules and actions and the norms of the society, customs, etc.

The revelation, except in some cases, has not provided a list of all things that are “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*maroof*) and “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) and we have to decide about them under the given guidance and assess is these within the domain of the permanent values. The Quran has merely provided the overall principles under which a Quranic society makes its own list.

As such, “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*maroof*) is that which is recognized by a Quranic society and “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) is that which such a society does not recognize as acceptable. As such, it is said in Surah *Al-Moomta'hina* that any list of “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*maroof*) will not brook any opposition or disobedience to the Messenger (60:12). This means that everything that a Quranic society recognizes as, will be treated as law, and a Quranic society can only recognize those things as law, as are under the guidance of the Quran. Anything that is against the Quran shall be deemed unlawful, and will be “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) not “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*maroof*). This is the basis on which “مَعْرُوفٌ” (*maroof*) and “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*) are determined and defined.

N-K-S

ن ك س

“نَكَسَ” (*nakasa*), “يَنْكُسُ” (*yankus*): to overturn something, to turn it over.

“إِنْتَكَسَ فُلَانٌ” (*intakasa fulanun*): so and so flipped.

“الْمُنْكِسُ” (*al-munakkis*): the horse that walks with a hung head due to some weakness, the horse which cannot keep up with other horses in a race.

“الْأَنَّاكِسُ” (*un-naakis*): one whose head is hung {*T-R-M*}.

Surah *Al-Ambia* says that the messenger *Ibrahim* had made the leaders and elite of his people understand through reasoning as to why idol worship was beneath human dignity. They accepted his reasoning too, but later their vested interests forced them to revert to their old ways. This has been mentioned by the Quran:

21:65	After reaching the loftiness of high understanding they fell flat on their faces (they reverted and fell back in the depths that they were languishing in before)	ثُمَّ نَكَّسُوا عَلَىٰ رُءُوسِهِمْ
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Surah *Assajdah* says:

32:12	Those who hang their heads in shame	نَاكِسُوا رُؤُوسِهِمْ
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Surah *Yaseen* says:

36:86	He who reaches old age (because of the weakness in the limbs) returns from the loftiness of youth to the depths of old age, and the knowledge he enjoys in young age is also forgotten by him	وَمَنْ نُعَمِّرْهُ نُنَكِّسْهُ فِي الْخَلْقِ
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Also see (36:86), (16:70) and (22:5).

This weakening of the limbs is a general statement and may vary from person to person.

N-K-Sd ن ك ص

“تَكْصَنَ عَنِ الْأَمْرِ” (*nakasa unil amr*): to hesitate from doing something, and to move back.

“تَكْصَنَ عَلَى عَقِبَيْهِ” (*nakisa ala aki'baihi*): turned away or reverted. It is said that this word means “to turn away from good” but generally means “to come back” {T, M}.

“تَكْصَنَ عَلَى عَقِبَيْهِ” (*nakasa ala aqi'baihi*): to revert or to turn back on one's footsteps.

Ibn Faris says this encompasses the meaning of “turning back due to fear”. With reference to *Ibn Dureed* says that this word is used to mean “to turn back from goodness”.

N-K-F ن ك ف

“تَكَفَّ” (*nakaf*): to cut something or to separate it and move it to one side {R}. *Ibn Faris* too supports this meaning.

“تَكَفَّتِ الدَّمْعُ” (*nakafatid dam'eh*): to separate tears from eyes or cheeks, i.e. to wipe the tears {R}.

“اسْتَنْكَفَ” (*istankaf*): to stop, to be shy of some work, to think the work bad and beneath one's dignity {T}.

“رَجُلٌ نِكْفٌ” (*rajulun nikfoon*): the man who is hated.

The Quran says:

4:174	Jesus or <i>Maseeh</i> (which Christians think is the son of God) did not flinch from the fact that he was on the mission of Allah.	لَنْ يَسْتَنْكَفَ الْمَسِيحُ أَنْ يَكُونَ عَبْدًا لِلَّهِ
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Thus here it is a case of the witness being more interested than the plaintiff, so to say, because Jesus as a human being is proud of being on the mission of Allah, and you are bent upon making him your God?

N-K-L ن ك ل

“الْأَنْكَلُ” (*un-niklu*): very strong and hard fetters or leg irons. The plural is “الْأَنْكَالُ” (*ankaalu*) i.e. “a very hard rein or the iron in a rein. This has led to the word “نَكَّلَهُ” (*nakkilih*) meaning “to stop someone from following the path that he is currently treading”.

“نَكَّلَ عَنْهُ” (*nakala unhu*): to turn in one's step, or change one's direction.

“نَكَّلَ بِهِ” (*nakkala bihi*): he received harsh punishment for the crime, because punishment is a deterrent to further crime, and it is an example for others to learn from too {T, F}.

The Quran says about the opponents in the Quresh tribe:

73:12	We have very hard fetters for them	إِنَّ لَدَيْنَا أَنْكَالًا
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Obviously these fetters are that which the opponents were made to wear in the battles of **Badr** and **Hunain** i.e. “they were killed and defeated” or all the ways in which these opponents were stopped from their opposition. These fetters shall be for those to wear who oppose the truth, and these fetters shall be an impediment in their evolutionary process in the hereafter. This is what is called hell or **jahannam**.

Surah **An-Na’zi’aat** says by punishing Pharaoh that Allah made him an eye opening example for posterity. Here “الْأَخْذُ” (**akhaz**) will mean the same as “اتَّخَذَ” (**attakhaza**).

As said above, “نَكَالٌ” (**nakalan**) will include all the ways in which a man is stopped from traversing the wrong path and he shall be punished severely.

As such, Surah **Al-Baqrah** says that those among the Jews who defied the orders of observing the Sabbath were given such punishment that they became **nakala** or examples (2:69).

In the same way it is said about the crime of **Sirqa** or theft that the Quran has suggested such punishment as would stop the criminal from further crime, i.e. the punishment will serve as deterrence for similar crimes, i.e. the purpose of punishment is to prevent the crime happening in the first place.

Deterrent punishment after a crime has been committed is also a sort of deterrent, and in agreeable conditions the criminal can be pardoned, if the criminal is ashamed or repentant over what he has done. (5:36-39). This includes both these possibilities.

N-M-R-Q ن م ر ق

“النُّمْرُقُ” (**an-numruq**), “النُّمْرُقَةُ” (**an-numruqah**): cushion or pillow which the rider lays down below the saddle on the back of a horse or a camel {**T**}.

The Quran says:

88:15	Lined up cushions	نَمَارِقٌ مَصْفُوفَةٌ
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Ibn Faris says the “ق” (**qaf**) in this word is additional. The real word he says is “نَمِرَةٌ” (**namirah**) which means “a lined blanket”, probably because the cushions were made of such blankets.

N-M-L ن م ل

“النَّمْلُ” (**an-naml**) is the plural of “نَمْلَةٌ” (**namlah**) which means “ants” {**T, Qamoos**}.

The tale of **Suleman** says:

27:18	Until they came to the valley of namal , then a namlah said, oh you namlahs , enter your dwellings	حَتَّىٰ إِذَا أَتَوْا عَلَىٰ وَادِ النَّمْلِ قَالَتْ نَمْلَةٌ يَا أَيُّهَا النَّمْلُ ادْخُلُوا مَسْكِنَكُمْ
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According to **Taj** the valley of **Namal** is between **Jabreen** and **Asqalaan**. Some say that this valley is in Syria, but if this valley was situated on the road to the country which led to the land of Queen **Saba**, then it would be situated near Yemen. However, the valley of **Namal** is not a place where ants lived, as generally believed and quoted in many translations. It is the name of a residential place of a tribe, and “النَّمْلُ” (**an-namal**) is the name of this tribe. “نَمْلَةٌ” (**namlah**) is the name of a woman of that tribe. It seems women were the head of that tribe, i.e. their culture was matriarchal e.g. like the Queen Sheba of Yemen.

“النَّامِلُ” (**anaamil**) is the plural for “أَنْمَلَةٌ” (**anmulah**) which means “tips of the fingers” (3:118).

“النَّم” (*an-nam*): to incite, instigate, to garnish a lie further.

“النَّمِيمَةُ” (*an-namimah*): snide, a whisper, the sound of writing something.

“النَّامَةُ” (*an-nammah*): movement.

“النَّمَّامُ” (*an-nammam*): someone who cannot hold on to a secret and talks about it here and there.

The Quran says:

68:11	one who conveys news from one place to others (in mischief)	مَشَاءٍ يَنْمِيهِ
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Here “نَمِيمٌ” (*nameem*) meant what “نَمِيمَةٌ” (*nameemah*) means, that is, “tremendous lies to create chaos among people” and “one who exaggerates for this purpose”.

“نَاءٌ” (*naa'a*), “يُنُوْءُ” (*yanu'u*), “نَوْءٌ” (*nau'un*): to get up with difficulty.

“نَاءٌ بِالْحِمْلِ” (*naa'a bil himl*): he got up with difficulty under the load.

“نَاءٌ بِهِ الْحِمْلُ” (*naa'a bihi himl*): the load burdened him and bent him {*T, M*}.

The Quran says about the treasures of *Qaaroon*:

28:76	A powerful group could lift them with difficulty	لَنُؤْءَ بِالْعُصْبَةِ
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Ibn Faris says “نَاءٌ” (*naa'a*) meant that “he lifted the burden with difficulty”.

“النَّوْبُ” (*an-naub*): for something to return time and again.

“نَوْبٌ” (*naub*): honey bees, because they return to their hives time and again.

“نَاءِيَةٌ” (*naa'ibah*): an event or accident. The plural is “نَوَائِبٌ” (*nawa'ib*), because an event returns many times during a lifetime.

“نَوْبَةٌ” (*nubah*), “نَوْبَةٌ” (*naubah*): turn, rather a turn to drink water.

“الْمَنَاابُ” (*al-manaab*): path to go towards the water, because people pass by it by turns.

“النِّيَابَةُ” (*an-niyabah*): to replace, turn over.

“أَنَابَ زَيْدٌ عَنْهُ وَكِيلًا” (*anaaba zaidun unhu wakila*): Zaid replaced himself with a lawyer (represented himself with a lawyer) {*T, M, R*}.

It is a special term of the Quran:

39:54	a honey bee travels far and wide in search of honey	أَنِيْبُوا إِلَىٰ رَبِّكُمْ
30:31	it searches for honey in different gardens and valleys, but returns to the hive every time with its payload of honey	مُنِيْبِينَ إِلَيْهِ

Wherever a bee goes it returns to the hive or the centre and wherever it may be the hive remains the centre of its thoughts. It does not disappear even for a moment. It is the *qiblah* of all its attention. In the journey of life this condition is for a *momin* too. Wherever in the world it may be and in whichever department, the centre of his attention remains the Quranic values and their establishment. For every decision in his life he refers to these values and refers to these values as a reference for every vent of his life:

2:154	And wherever you are, focus your attention on this centre	وَحَيْثُ مَا كُنْتُمْ فَوَلُّوا وُجُوهَكُمْ شَطْرَهُ
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About the bee it is said:

16:96	Suck the honey from all the fruits (and flowers) and keep faithfully traversing the path ordained by your Sustainer	ثُمَّ كُلِي مِنْ كُلِّ الثَّمَرَاتِ فَاسْلُكِي سُبُلَ رَبِّكِ ذُلُلًا
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A **momin** gains knowledge on a global basis and becomes expert in science and technology, but his centre is always the Quranic values. Then he uses his skills for the benefit of mankind according to the dictates of the Quran. This is what “إِنَابَتِ إِلَى اللَّهِ” (**inabatillaah**) means, i.e. “to refer to the revelation at every juncture of life and to take guidance from there.

The **Lataif-ul-Lugha** says “توبه” (**taubah**) means for expressing shame or regret when committed a mistake, and to be protected against such mistakes in future, i.e. in “توبه” (**taubah**) a man reverts to the right path after traversing the wrong path, but in “توبه” (**anabat**) he deliberates over which step to take and then takes the right step. Hence it is not only preventive (against future mistakes) but also curative (against past mistakes).

“نَاَحَ” (*naah*): he cried loudly.

“نَوَّحَ” (*nauh*): the women who gather for wailing in this way.

“النَّيَّاحَةُ” (*an-niyahah*): to lament in this way.

“النَّوَّاحُ” (*an-naawuh*): to be in front of each other the way women are while wailing or doing the “نَوَّحَ” (*nauha*) {*T, R*}.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is “to be in front of each other”.

Nouh

نُوحٌ

“نُوحٌ” (*nouh*), or *Noah*, as in (7:59). It is a non-Arabic word. Some say that this is the title of the messenger Noah because he used to plead a lot (before God) {*T, R*}, but the better of the two reasoning seems to be that it is a non-Arabic word.

The Quran has started the stories of the messengers with the mention of *Nuuh*.

Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:163	Verily We have endowed you with the revelation like We had sent it towards other messengers after <i>Noah</i>	إِنَّا أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْكَ كَمَا أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَى نُوحٍ وَالنَّبِيِّينَ مِنْ بَعْدِهِ---
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Although at one place, *Noah* has been mentioned along with *Adam*. See heading (*A-D-M*). This shows that the guidance to human beings had been imparted since the time of *Noah*. Scholars have been debating now for a long time as to which part of the world mankind began in and from which descendants, but now the direction of research is that mankind was begun from Arabia where the *Saami* generation was the original human generation. *Noah* was sent towards this nation about six to seven thousand years ago from now. The Quran in this context argues neither about the place where it all began nor the time. It focuses instead on the life and death (or the rise and fall) of nations. It does not concern itself with such historic details as it is not a book of history – the Quran deals with the human self and its development individually as well as in a collective system. The Quran refers to the relative and the permanent values and spells out the consequences of following these values.

Noah was an individual in his nation. Therefore the Quran has called him the brother of his nation:

26:106	When their brother <i>Nuuh</i> said to them...	إِذْ قَالَ لَهُمْ أَخُوهُمْ نُوحٌ
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Although the Quran talks about messenger-hood with the mention of *Noah*, it appears that other messengers before him had also been sent to these people.

The Quran says:

25:37	When the nation of <i>Nuuh</i> denied the messengers, we drowned them	وَقَوْمٌ نُوحٍ لَّمَّا كَذَّبُوا الرُّسُلَ أَغْرَقْنَاهُمْ
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It seems that humanity was still in its infancy in those days, and they were unable to fulfill even small requirements of a civilized life. Therefore *Noah* was told or taught how to make a boat:

11:37	We sent our guidance to <i>Nuuh</i> ...so that under our guidance he could make a boat.	وَاصْنَعِ الْفُلَکَ بِأَعْيُنِنَا وَوَحِّينَا---
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Noah's message was also that which the teaching of Allah is i.e.:

7:59	O' my people, obey Allah. There is no God except Him	يَقُومُوا عِبَادُوا اللَّهَ مَا لَكُمْ مِنْ إِلَهٍ غَيْرُهُ
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This nation used to worship many idols or gods (71:32). If **Noah's** message was only to worship Allah and no idols, then the entire nation would obviously oppose him. However, the Quran says that the lower strata of society welcomed his message (26:111) and the big-wigs of the nation opposed it (11:27). This means that the message was such that the big-wigs saw annihilation in it for them and the poor saw it as livening for them. This was the section of society which was hated by the rich community because they were thought to be lowly (11:27, 26:11).

The big-wigs opposed the message tooth and nail, and went so far as to threaten **Noah** (54:9), and the opposition increased so much that **Noah** feared being overwhelmed (54:10). Then a storm occurred (54:11-12). The opponents were drowned and **Noah** along with the faithful who followed him climbed the boat he built and reached safety.

The Quran has mentioned in this connection that the 'others' who believed in the revelation became his "own", while his own son and wife (who had not believed in his message) were declared to be not from his family (121:46, 66:10). This shows clearly that from day one the revelation had declared that the **muslim** nation is based on an ideology and not descent or any other blood relation.

About **Noah**, the Quran says:

29:14	He stayed there fifty less than one thousand years	فَلَبِثَ فِيهِمْ أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ إِلَّا خَمْسِينَ عَامًا
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This is taken to mean that **Noah's** age was about 950 years, but in olden times a 'king's life' meant the duration of his family's reign. According to this, **Noah's** 950 years mean the period when his laws and orders prevailed. The other meaning is "سَنَةٍ" (*alaf sanat*) or "the one crop out of the four in a year". As such "أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ" (*alfa sinatin*) means 250 years. Now if 50 years are taken out, then that leaves 200 years which is not feasible. For more details, see (*S-N-W*) and (*Ain-W-M*).

N-W-R ن و ر

"النُّورُ" (*an-nuur*): light (of any kind), or the rays of light. In "ضِيَاءٌ" (*zia*) there is more intensity than light, therefore the Quran uses "ضِيَاءٌ" (*zia*) to mean the sun's light and "نُورٌ" (*noor*) to mean moonlight {*T*}. See heading (*Zd-W-A*).

10:5	God has created the sun illuminating and the moon bright	هُوَ الَّذِي جَعَلَ الشَّمْسُ ضِيَاءً وَالْقَمَرَ نُورًا
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The difference will only be between "ضِيَاءٌ" (*zia*) and "نُورٌ" (*noor*) if they are used against each other at one place. That difference is that "ضِيَاءٌ" (*zia*) is self-evident and illuminates other things {*T*}.

Allah has called His Book (the Quran) as "نُورٌ" (*noor*). Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:15	Verily the light (the Book) has come to you	فَدَجَّائِكُمْ مِنَ اللَّهِ نُورٌ كِتَابٌ مُبِينٌ
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Light is reason for itself, i.e. it is not dependant on any other thing for making itself evident. Therefore the Quran is so distinct and self-evident that it needs no illumination or any external light. The other characteristic of light is that it fixes everything in its place. That is, everything can be seen clearly in their places in the light.

In other words, the Quran relates what place everything enjoys and what be its true value. This is what is called "guidance", i.e. "to distinguish between what is right and what is wrong". As such, while Allah has declared the Quran as "نُورٌ" (*noor*), He has also related what He means by it:

5:16	Allah guides anyone who agrees with His laws towards security and completion of personality and thus brings them out of the darkness towards the light and thus guides them to a straight path	يَهْدِي بِهِ اللَّهُ مَنِ اتَّبَعَ رِضْوَانَهُ سُبُلَ السَّلَامِ وَيُخْرِجُهُم مِّنَ الظُّلُمَاتِ إِلَى النُّورِ بِإِذْنِهِ وَيَهْدِيهِمْ
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		إِلَى صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ
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This means that “He guides them towards the balanced path of life”.

6:123	These people take this beacon of light with them everywhere they go.	جَعَلْنَا لَهُ نُورًا يَمْشِي بِهِ فِي النَّاسِ
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“مَنَارَةٌ” (*manaratu*) and “مَنَارٌ” (*manarah*) is the place from where light is emitted, and also a place from where the call to prayers is made.

“مَنَارٌ” (*manar*): the boundary which is created to distinguish between two things {*T*}.

“مُنِيرٌ” (*muneer*): a pleasant thing or lighted thing or man {*T*}. It also means one who lights up or illuminates.

Some say that “النَّارُ” (*an-naar*) and “النُّورُ” (*an-nuur*) are actually the same (2:17).

“نَارٌ” (*naar*): a flame if it can be seen {*T*}.

“النَّارُ” (*an-naar*): a symbol, because the Arabs used to brand their camels with a branding iron and this process was called “نَارٌ” (*naar*) {*T*}.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “نَارٌ” (*naar*) and “نُورٌ” (*noor*) sometimes are used in the same meaning, but the reasoning for doing so is not very weighty.

“نُورٌ” (*noor*) is thought to be good and “نَارٌ” (*naar*) has the element of hatred and frustration.

“نَارَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ تَنُورُ” (*naaratul mar atut tanur*): for the woman to dislike and be frustrated. It is also used for strange animals like deer.

“بَقَرَةٌ نَوَارٌ” (*baqratun nawaar*): a cow which is averse to an ox.

“مُنَاوَرَةٌ” (*munawarah*): to be mutually abusive.

“نَائِرَةٌ” (*naa-irah*): enmity, because it is an internal fire too.

“نَائِرَةُ الْحَرْبِ” (*na-irat-ul-herb*): the chaos of war {*T*}.

“نَارُ الْحَرْبِ” (*naar-ul-herb*): the fire atop a mountain which signified war {*Ruh-ul-Ma'ani*}.

“نَارُ الْقَوْمِ” (*naaral qaum*): the nation accepted defeat {*M*}. This makes the meaning of “عَذَابُ النَّارِ” (*azaabin naar*) clear, i.e. the result of destructive deeds of man which burn life to a cinder, as against *jannat* where canals are flowing. Here the depiction of the opposition of fire and water explains the meanings. See heading (*N-H-R*). This includes the destruction in this life as well as in the life hereafter.

“أَصْحَابُ النَّارِ” (*as'haabin naar*): are the people who are embroiled in “خوف” (*khauf*) and “حزن” (*huzn*) i.e. fear and grief (plight) (2:38:39).

This fire engulfs the hearts:

104:6	The fire that is made by the laws of God and which engulfs the hearts	نَارُ اللَّهِ الْمُوقَدَةُ الَّتِي تَطْلُعُ عَلَى الْأَفْئِدَةِ
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For more details see the heading *Jahannam* and (*J-H-M*).

The Quran has said in verse (38:76) that “إبليس” (*Iblees*) has been created from “نَارٌ” (*naar*). Therefore wherever it has been cautioned or exhorted to avoid “نَارٌ” (*naar*), it means to avoid the ways of *Iblees* who is the embodiment of evil forces.

“عَذَابُ النَّارِ” (*azaabun naar*): destructive deeds which distort man’s social and civilized life as well as his own Self. Thus both his worldly life as well as the life hereafter is wasted.

Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

15:27	And the Jinn We had created earlier from fire.	وَالْجَانَّ خَلَقْنَاهُ مِنْ قَبْلُ مِنْ نَارِ السَّمُومِ
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“جَانٌّ” (*ja'anna*) points to all the things or forces that are invisible to man. Here “نَارِ السَّمُومِ” (*naari samoom*), or “very strong fire” may mean the hot state of matter when it has not attained any form, i.e. in the formulated stage like the fires of atom etc. But it can also mean the creatures that inhabited this earth prior to man and which are now extinct. Man is the successor to these creatures. See heading (*Kh-L-H*). Since in those times the earth was hotter, those creatures must have had more capability to stand heat.

Maybe it is said that it was created out of “نَار” (*naar*) or fire just as it has been said that man was created from soil/dust.

For the meanings of *Iblees* and *Jinn* etc. see heading (*B-L-S*) and (*J-N-N*).

Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:35	Allah is the light of the heavens and the earth.	اللَّهُ نُورُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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This is generally taken to mean that this is a similarity about God himself, but this is not right. Man cannot even visualize about the personae of God. Here Allah has said “مَثَلُ نُورِهِ” (*masali noorih*), i.e. the example of that “نُور” (*noor*) is like (as expostulated ahead).

“نُورُ اللَّهِ” (*noor-ullaha*) or (God’s *noor*) is a very comprehensive word or phrase and has been used at several places in the Quran. Its comprehensiveness can be understood by saying that wherever there be light in the universe God is the source of that light, the light of the intellect, the light (emancipation) of knowledge, the light (Revelation) etc. All are given by God, and this light includes the Quran.

N-W-Sh ن و ش

- “النَّوْشُ” (*an-naush*): to take something.
 “تَنَاشَى” (*tanawasha-hu*): he took it.
 “النَّوْشُ” (*an-naush*): to demand.
 “النَّوْشُ” (*an-nawush*): a strong man with a strong grip.
 “نَاشٍ بِهِ” (*naashun*), “يَنْوُشُ” (*bihi yanush*): he clung to him and hung onto him {*T*}.
 “نَاشٍ فَلَانًا” (*naasha fulana*): he caught him and pulled him by the beard and by the head {*T*}.

The Quran says:

34:52	How can they believe now as this opportunity has gone far out of their reach?	وَأَنَّى لَهُمُ التَّنَاقُشُ
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N-W-Sd ن و ص

“النَّوْصُ” (*an-naus*): to move back.

Ibn Faris says this root means “to come and go”.

- “النَّوْصُ” (*an-naus*): to escape.
 “نَاصٌ” (*naasa*), “يَنْوُصُ” (*yanusu*), “نَوَصًا” (*nusa*): to be mobile and go somewhere, to escape by running away.
 “نَاصَ عَنْهُ” (*naasa unhu*): he turned back from him, avoided him and eluded him, moved to one side.
 “نَاصَ إِلَى كَذَا” (*naasa ila kaza*): he sought sanctuary with him {*T*}.

The Quran says:

38:3	There was no time for turning back and seeking refuge { <i>F</i> }	وَلَا تَجِدُ مَنَاصِي
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“مَنَاصٌ” (*manaas*): the place which one runs way from and also to run away.

“النَّاقَةُ” (*an-naaqah*): a she-camel when it attains maturity (almost in the fourth year).

“النَّيِّقَةُ” (*an-neeqah*): to make the food and dress very exquisite, fine-ness (finesse), expertise.

“تَنَوَّقَ” (*qanawwaqa fil amr*): to excel in something, to employ fine-ness (finesse) in some work.

Taj-ul-Uroos says with reference to *Ibn Faris* that this word has been derived from “نَاقَةُ” (*naaqah*) because the Arabs consider a she-camel to be a very fine animal. Just as “جَمَلٌ” (*jamal*) and “أَجْمَلٌ” (*ajmal*) are derived from “جَمَالٌ” (*jamal*) which means the most beautiful, “الْمُنَوَّقُ” (*al-munawwaq*) and “تَنَوَّقَ” (*tanawwaq*) have been derived from “نَاقَةُ” (*naaqah*) which means “a cleaned husk (or cover) of the date” {*T, M*}.

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is “to rise and be lofty”. Perhaps a she-camel or camel is called “النَّاقَةُ” (*an-naaqah*) because of its height.

The nation of *Samood* had shortage of water. See heading (*Te-M-D*). Whatever water was accumulated was reserved by the big-wigs of the nation for themselves and their animals, while animals of the poor died of thirst. Messenger *Saleh* told these people that to reserve the water for a section of the people which has been provided by God free of cost for all creations is unjust. He told them to desist from this path or they would be destroyed. Thus after a lot of argument they agreed that everyone should water their animals by turn.

Saleh agreed and presented a camel which he would let loose and see whether it was allowed by them to drink water in its turn or not. If it was allowed to drink on its turn then it would mean that they were sticking to the agreement, but if they did not, then it would mean that they had made the agreement only superficially. They as expected, did not stick to their agreement and killed the camel without considering the consequences.

The Quran calls it “نَاقَةُ اللَّهِ” (*naaqatul laah*) in (7:73), i.e. “the camel among Allah’s creatures” which was a symbol “لَكُمْ آيَةٌ” (*lakum ayatan*) to determine whether they, (the people) stuck to the agreement they had made with Allah or not. The manner in which Allah has called the “كَعْبَهُ” (*ka’ba*) as “Allah’s house”, this she-camel has been called “نَاقَةُ اللَّهِ” (*naqatil laah*) or “Allah’s camel” in the Quran.

“النَّائِلُ” (*an-nayl*), “النَّائِلُ” (*an-naa’il*): the gift or benevolence that man receives.

“نَالَ” (*naal*): he received.

“نَالَ مِنْ عَدُوِّهِ مَطْلُوبَهُ” (*naala min aduwwahi matlubahi*): wanted to hurt his enemy and he did it {*T, M, R*}, and thus got what he wanted.

“نَالَتُهُ” (*an-naltuhu*), “يَا هُ وَلَيْتُهُ” (*iyياهو wa niltuhu*): I made him acquire something, or made to reach him.

“نَالَ الرَّحِيلُ” (*maalat raheel*): the time for departure approached closer.

“تَنَوَّعَ” (*tanweel*): to bestow.

“النَّوَالُ” (*an-nawaal*): bestow {*F*}.

“النَّيْلُ” (*an-neel*): the river Nile.

“عِظْلَمُ” (*izlam*): a tree used to make the washing blue {*T, M, R*}. This word is Arabized from the word “Nile”.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:124	My promise is not for the rebellious	لَا يَتَّبِعُ عَهْدِي الظَّالِمِينَ
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Those who are rebellious to Allah’s guidance and take away from the human rights, they do not have His promise that they will lead mankind.

The Quran says:

9:120	Neither do they hurt the enemies	لَا يَنْتَالُونَ مِنْ عَدُوِّ نَبَلًا
7:49	Allah will not be kind to them (they will not enjoy Allah's mercy)	لَا يَتَأْتُهُمُ اللَّهُ بِرَحْمَةٍ

N-W-M ن و م

“النَّوْمُ” (*an-naum*): sleep (2:255, 78:9).

“مَنَامٌ” (*manaam*): the place or time to sleep, or sleep and dream (39:42, 37:102). It also means “the eyes” because sleep is in the eyes {T}.

Surah *Al-Anfaal* says:

8:42	Allah made you all appear few in their eyes (to them)	إِذْ يُرِيكُمُ اللَّهُ فِي مَنَامِكُمْ
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Here some scholars have taken the word to mean “the eye” {T}.

“نَامَتِ الرِّيحُ” (*naamatir reeh*): the wind went to sleep or became motionless.

“نَامَتِ النَّارُ” (*naamatir naar*): heat of the fire and its intensity decreased.

“نَامَ عَنْ حَاجَتِهِ” (*naama un haajatih*): he became heedless of his need.

“النُّومَةُ” (*an-numah*): he who is not considered worth attention, he who is considered valueless.

“النَّوِيمُ” (*an-naweem*): the man who is unmindful of his things. It also means “anonymous” {M}.

“إِسْتَنَامَ إِلَى فُلَانٍ” (*istanaam ala fulaan*): he was satisfied at reaching there.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “static” and “for movement to stop”.

N-W-N ن و ن

“نُونٌ” (*noon*) is the pronunciation of the Arabic letter “N”. It is N in the Syrian and Hebrew languages too.

It basically means “a big fish”, because the ancient form of this letter resembled a fish {M, *Lissan-ul-Arab*}.

The Quran has called messenger *Yunus* as “ذَا النُّونِ” (*zun noon*) in (21:87) as well as “صَاحِبِ الْحُوتِ” (*saahib-ul-haut*) in (68:49) i.e. “the man of the fish”. In Surah *As-Saffaat* he has been called *Yunus* (37:139).

As per Taureefat (Definitions) s (*noon*) means “potential knowledge”, which means “inkpot”, because the letters that are framed by the ink are potentially present in the inkpot. This means that the literal meaning of this word is “inkpot” but the figurative meaning is “potential knowledge”.

Surah *Al-Qalam* says:

68:1	whatever the pen (and the inkpot) write (knowledge is witness to...what they write)	وَالْقَلَمِ وَمَا يَسْطُرُونَ
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“نُونٌ” (*noon*) here may be from the terminated words.

Taj-ul-Uroos and *Aqarab-ul-Muwaarid* say that the meaning of “نُونٌ” (*noon*) is also “the sharpness of the blade of the sword”. Verse (68:1) would then mean “the sword and whatever the pen writes are witnesses to the fact that Allah's *Deen* will at last triumph”. Here sword resembles the power to implement and ink resembles the power of written knowledge of the laws of Allah i.e. the revelation.

The Quran and the sword are the argument or evidence which cannot be matched by anything as reason (which cannot be reasoned against), and no claim of the Quran can remain without reason.

Surah *Al-Hadeed* says in this context that Allah sent the messengers and sent the Books of guidance with them as well as the sword:

57:25	Which has strong power and many benefits for mankind	فِيهِ بَأْسٌ شَدِيدٌ وَمَنَافِعُ لِلنَّاسِ
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Note that by saying “the Quran” and “the sword” together does not mean that the Quran will be made acceptable on the basis of the sword. It means that a society will be established in which Quranic laws will be implemented. This force has been symbolized by the sword. The force that is responsible for enforcing justice in this world and which is used against the destructive forces of evil.

N-W-Y

ن و ي

“نَوَى الشَّيْءَ يَنْوِيهِ” (*nawash shaiya yanwih*): to decide or intend something, to decide firmly, and to really be attentive towards it.

Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings:

- The intent about something.
- The seed of anything.

“النِّيَّةُ” (*an-niyatuh*): the direction in which one travels {*T*}, to intend firmly to do something, some think it means to be ready to do something for benefit and to get rid of the loss {*M*}.

“تَوَاكَ اللَّهُ” (*nawakal laah*): may Allah be with you in your journey and may He protect you.

“النَّوَى” (*an-nawi*): companion, or a companion during a journey with the same intent {*T*}.

“النَّوَا” (*an-nawat*): seed. The plural is “النَّوَى” (*an-nawa*) as in (6:66).

“نَوَاةُ التَّمْرِ” (*nawatut tamr*): the seed of a date.

N-He-J

ن ه ج

“النَّهْجُ” (*an-nahj*), “الْمِنْهَاجُ” (*al-minhaaj*): clear path.

“النَّهْجُ الطَّرِيقُ وَالْأَمْرُ” (*an-hajat tareequ wal amr*): the path and the matter became clear.

“نَهَجَ الْأَمْرُ” (*nahajal amr*) also means the same thing as above.

“فُلَانٌ اسْتَنْهَجَ طَرِيقَ فُلَانٍ” (*fulanun istanhaja tareeqa fulanin*): that man followed that way {*T, M, R*}.

The Quran uses “مِنْهَاجًا” (*minahaja*) in (5:48). For its detailed meaning, see heading (*Sh-R-Ain*).

N-He-R

ن ه ر

Ibn Faris says “نَهَرَ” (*nahr*) basically means for something to open up.

“أَنْهَرْتُ الدَّمَ” (*anharatud dum*): I opened the wound and let the blood flow.

“نَهْرٌ” (*nahr*): the place where water is allowed to flow from. Some think that “نَهْرٌ” (*nahr*) actually means “water” and the place it flows along is called “نَهْرٌ” (*nahr*) too. The plural is “أَنْهَارٌ” (*anhaar*).

“النَّهْرُ” (*an-nahr*), “نَهْرٌ” (*nahr*): vastness and expansion:

The Quran says:

54:54	The righteous will be in the paradise and will have abundance of everything	إِنَّ الْمُتَّقِينَ فِي جَنَّاتٍ وَنَهَرٍ
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“النَّهِيرُ” (*an-naheer*): abundant and prolific {T}.
 “النَّهَارُ” (*an-nahaar*): day (light), i.e. the opposite of “الليل” (*lail*) (night).
 “النَّهْرَةُ” (*an-nahrah*): to snatch something away.
 “نَهَرَ الرَّجُلُ نَهْرًا” (*naharar rajulu nahra*): the man attacked in the daytime {T}.
 “نَهَرَ الرَّجُلُ” (*naharar rajul*): he scolded (talked harshly) that man.
 “الْمَنْهَرَةُ” (*al-manharah*): the open space in front of a house where garbage is kept or thrown {T}.

93:10	Do not think the needy are lowly	وَأَمَّا السَّائِلَ فَلَا تَنْهَرْ
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About parents it is said:

17:23	Do not scold them or talk harshly to them (do not demean them and talk to them nicely)	فَلَا تَقُلْ لَهُمَا أَفٍّ وَلَا تَنْهَرْهُمَا وَقُلْ لَهُمَا قَوْلًا كَرِيمًا
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The Quran talks time and again about the *jannah*:

2:25	Canals will be flowing beneath those gardens	تَجْرِي مِنْ تَحْتِهَا الْأَنْهَارُ
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In Arabic, “النَّهْرُ” (*la nahr*) means the body of water which flows between two pieces of land. This may include river or the sea or canals which irrigate fields and gardens {L}.

Wherever *jannah* refers to an ideal worldly society, its canals mean that it shall always be flourishing:

13:35	Its fruits and benefits will be everlasting	أَكْثُلُهَا دَائِمٌ وَظِلُّهَا
14:25	it keeps producing its fruits (benefits)	أَنْهَارٌ

And *jannah* means the life hereafter and all its details that are related and are symbolic only (47:15, 13:35). Therefore the canals mentioned there are also not those that come to our mind as we think of canals in this life.

The Quran has said that water is life (21:30) and everyone knows this for a fact. Therefore in a society where there is abundance of water, there will be a flourishing of life. For canals to be flowing in the gardens is an allegory to flourishing life.

N-He-Y ن ه ي

“نَهَاهُ” (*nahahu*), “يَنْهَاهُ” (*yanhahu*), “نَهْيًا” (*nahya*): is the opposite of “أَمَرَ” (*amar*), i.e. “to prevent”, “to stop”, “to make abstain”.

“إِنْتَهَى” (*intaha*): to abstain, to stop.

“الْأَنْهْيَةُ” (*an-nuhyah*): the extreme limit of anything.

“النَّهْيَةُ” (*an-nihaya*): the same as above {T}.

Ibn Faris says this root’s basic meaning is “to reach the limit”. Everything stops after reaching the limit and therefore this word means to stop.

“النُّهْيَةُ” (*an-nuhyah*): intellect, because it stops man from doing certain deeds. The plural is “النُّهْيُ” (*an-nuha*) {T}. It also means “intellect” or “to stop”. See heading (*Ain-Q-L*).

“رَجُلٌ مَنِهَاتٌ” (*rajulun manhaat*): a man on whose opinion people depend {T}.

The Quran says:

3:109	if they desist from fighting	يَنْهَوْنَ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ
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“مَعْرُوفٌ” (*ma’roof*) and to stop from that which is “مُنْكَرٌ” (*munkar*). This is the duty of the *muslim ummat* (*Islamic System*): (for the meanings of *ma’roof* and *munkar*, see heading (*N-K-R*) and (*Ain-R-F*)).

“أُولَى النَّهَى” (*oolin nuha*): the intellectuals (20:54).

“إِنْتَهَى” (*intaha*): to stop (2:275).

“الْمُنْتَهَى” (*al-muntaha*): the extremity, last limit (53:14).

For the meaning of “سِدْرَةٌ” (*sidrah*), see heading (*S-D-R*).

“هـ” (*ha*): this pronoun is used at the end for the singular non-present subject.
 “يَنْصُرُونَهُ” (*yansaroonah*): those who would help him (28:81).
 “مَكَانَهُ” (*makaanah*) in (28:82), its place:

This pronoun is pronounced “هـ” (*hi*) or “بِهـ” (*bihi*), “مَايَهـ” (*maahiya*) and “كِتَابِيَهـ” (*kitaabiyah*).

Ha (verb) هَا

“هَا” (*ha*): this is used for singular, feminine subject that is not present, as “إِنَّهَا” (*innaha*) (2:71) and “لَوْنُهَا” (*launaha*) (2:69).

Ha هَا

“هَا” (*ha*): is used to mean “catch it”.
 “هَآؤُمْ أَقْرَأُ وَآ كِتَابِيَهـ” (*haa-umuq kitabiyah*): here, read my book (69:19). Here “أُم” (*oom*) has been increased to mean plural.

It also comes to mean “admonish”.
 “هَآ أَنْتُمْ أَوْلَآءُ” (*haa antum oola-i*): yes, you are the one.

When “هَا” (*ha*) appears after “أَيُّ” (*ayyu*), then it comes to mean “call upon”.
 “أَيُّهَا الرَّجُلُ” (*ayyuhar rajul*): O man!

Often before “أَيُّهَا” (*ayyuha*), “يَا” (*ya*) is added, like “يَا أَيُّهَا” (*ya ayyuha*).

The Quran says “يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ” (*ya ayyuhan naas*) to mean “O’ you people”.

For the meaning of “هَكَذَا” (*hakaza*) see heading *Haaza*.

Ha-oolai هَآؤُ لَآءُ

It is the plural of both “هَآ” (*haaza*) and “هَآزِيَهـ” (*haazihi*). It means “all these” (masculine and feminine).

For masculine only it is said “هَآ أَنْتُمْ هَآؤُ لَآءُ” (*ha’antum ha-oolai*) in (2:65), which means “beware, you are the people who...”

For feminine only, it is said “هَآؤُ لَآءُ بَنَاتِي” (*ha’oola-i binaati*) in (11:78), which means “all these are my daughters”.

Ha-oom هَآؤُمْ

See heading *Ha*.

“هَذَا” (*haaza*): this (masculine). “هَذَانِ” (*haazani*): this (feminine)
 “هَٰؤُلَاءِ” (*haazani haaz*): both these (for masculine and feminine both).
 “هَذِهِ” (*haazihi*): this (singular feminine).
 “هَاتَانِ هَاتَانِ” (*haataani haatain*): these two (for feminine)
 “هَٰؤُلَاءِ” (*ha oola-i*): all these (plural).
 “هَكَذَا” (*haakaza*): like this, such as this.
 “هَلْكَدَا عَرْشُكَ” (*ahaakaza arshuk*): was your throne similar to this? (27: 42).

“الْهَرْتُ” (*al-hart*): to pierce with the spear, to tear up a cloth to pieces.
 “الْهَرَاتُ” (*al-harat*): for the ends of the mouth to be wide.
 “الْهَرَيْتُ” (*al-hareet*): someone with wide ends of the mouth.
 “رَجُلٌ هَرَيْتُ” (*rajulun hareet*): the man who is abusive and keeps nothing undisclosed {T}.
 “هَارُوتُ” (*haaroot*): story tellers have made up many stories about **Suleman**. One of them is that there were two angels, named **Haaroot** and **Maruut**. They used to teach sorcery. The Quran has refuted these fabrications (2:102).

It is a non-Arabic word. Also see headings **Maruut** and **Babel**.

“هَارُونُ” (*Haroon*): this is a non-Arabic name. It was the name of **Moosa**’s brother and a messenger of the **Bani Israel**.

In pure Arabic language, “الْهَيْرُونُ” (*al-hairoon*) means “a fine quality date” {T}.

In support of their contention that there are messengers without a book too, some present the case of **Haroon** as evidence. They say that **Moosa** was granted a Book and **Haroon** was with him as messenger but was not granted a book. The Quran has clearly stated that the revelation as a Book was given both to **Moosa** and **Haroon** jointly:

37:117	And we gave them both the clear book	وَاتَيْنَاهُمَا الْكِتَابَ الْمُسْتَبِينَ
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For more details see the heading (**N-B-A**).

The Quran says that **Moosa** was sent towards the Pharaoh, **Haamaan** and **Qaaroona** (40:24) and these were among those who were to be destroyed (29:39) i.e. the system which they represented.

If we look at the history, we will find religious monastic more dominant than kingship anywhere. A king used to be a king only but a religious entity used to play god, a domination in which the king too was his subject. In Egypt **Aaman Ra** (the Sun God) was thought to be the greatest god. The high priest of his temple occupied a very prominent place in their society.

Dr. Standroff in his book “The Religion of the Ancient Egyptians” writes:

“The head astrologer (priest) of the **Aaman** god was called the first **nabi** (messenger). He was also an officer of the Works Dept. {probably religious buildings are referred here}. He was also responsible for

the embellishment of the temple. He was also the general of the soldiers of the temple. He was also the administrator of the treasury. He not only was the undisputed ruler of the temple of **Aaman** but he was the chief officer of all the temples of Thebes and western Egypt. It may be noted that Thebes's city alone had ten percentage of all Land in Egypt. Such was the grandeur of the head priest of the temple of **Aaman Ra**.

This very high priest is what is referred **Haamaan** in the Quran which is a change from the name **Aaman** over a period of time (just like the name **Aoron** changed to **Haroon**). Under the heading "**Egypt**", the **Encyclopedia Britannica** says: "From the time of the 18th family of the Pharaohs, the priests of the temples had attained a great importance. At this time the conquered areas of Asia had been dedicated to the priest of **Aamam Ra** (which was situated in Thebes) due to which he (the high priest) was the owner of immense wealth and power".

Dr. Brestead too in his book "The History of Egypt" has written that the High Priest of **Aaman** had a large army under him.

Thus one can understand why the Quran mentions the armies of **Haamaan** along with the Pharaohs (28:6) and why had the Pharaoh asked the **Haamaan** (or the high priest who was in charge of the building department) to build a high building or tower by climbing which he could peep at **Moosa's** God (40:36).

The fact is that whenever the message of the revelation was pronounced for the good of people at large, it was never opposed openly by the dictatorships of the time e.g. king, ruler, political leader, etc. It was the priesthood as a religious representative who raised the opposition and the political leadership took the backseat. The reason was that the religious priesthood controlled the emotions of the masses who blindly followed the hierarchy. This is what the Pharaoh did. He kept in the background and forced **Hamaan** and his sorcers to go forward to confront **Moosa**, but the staff of **Moosa** foiled all their aims:

7:117	And suddenly it swallowed what they were falsifying	فَإِذَا هِيَ تَلْقَفُ مَا يَأْفِكُونَ
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Dictatorships (human laws in all forms), priesthood, and capitalism, all three are great evils for mankind. The Quran has mentioned all three in detail while relating the events about the **Bani Israel**. The Pharaoh was the embodiment of oppression, exploitation, and cruelty.

Hamaan is the representative of the evil deeds of monasticism and **Qaroon** the embodiment of the evils of capitalism. The guidance through the revelation delivers mankind from all these three evils. The cure for these evils is in establishing a Quranic system in which there is no slave of any other human being and neither dependant on any other man. This is the true freedom which the Quran has advocated for a human being through the acceptance and the implementation of the permanent values.

He-B-T

ه ب ط

“هَبُوطٌ” (**hubut**): to climb down:

“هَبَطَ أَرْضَ كَذَا” (**haata arda kaza**): he landed on that land {T}.

Raghib says that it means to climb down under pressure or forced to climb down.

Muheet says “هَبَطَ مِنْ مَوْضِعٍ إِلَى مَوْضِعٍ” (**habata min mauzin ila mu'azih**) which means “he transferred from one place to another”.

The Quran says about the **Bani Israel** “هَبِطُوا مِصْرًا” (**ihbitu misra**) in (2:61), which means “you move from this life in the desert to some city”.

Raghib says that when the word “هَبُوطٌ” (**hubut**) is spoken for men, then it contains the element of insult, as opposed to **inzaal** which Allah has used at different places for respectable things too {R}.

“هَبَطَ الْمَرَضُ لَحْمَهُ” (**habatal maraza lahmahu**): the sickness reduced his flesh, made him weak.

“الْهَبْطَةُ” (**al-habtatu**): low land.

“الْهَبْتُ” (*al-habt*): loss. This word also means “to fall into ignominy” and “evil”.

“الْهَبَيْتُ” (*al-habeet*): a weak camel {*Ibn Faris*}.

“هَبْتُ” (*hubut*) means “the change from one state to another while the second state is inferior than the first state”.

The story about *Adam* in the Quran says that if men live as a single nation according to the guidance provided by the revelation, then this is the success of mankind, but if they live like enemies then it will be a return to a lower place.

2:36	We said now you go towards a lower place from this high place: now you will be each other's enemy	فَقُلْنَا اهْبِطُوا بَعْضُكُمْ لِبَعْضٍ عَدُوٌّ
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From this “هَبْتُ” (*hubut*) means that “mankind can return to the former high state if they live their lives according to the revelation (2:38). Details about this can be found under the heading (*A-D- M*) and (*Sh-J-R*).

He-B-W ه ب و

“الْهَبَاءُ” (*al-haba'u*): haze caused by dust, a very thin haze which looks like smoke in the atmosphere, or the fine dust which is seen as sunlight peeps in some dark room. It also means the dust raised by the hooves of horses {*T, R, M*}.

“الْهَبْوَةُ” (*al-habwah*): dust.

“هَبَّ الغُبَارُ” (*habal ghubaar*): the dust rose {*T, R, M*}.

“جَاءَ يَهْبِي” (*ja'a yatahabba*): he came empty handed raising dust.

“الْهَابِي” (*al-haabi*): the earth which falls into the grave (while burying a dead person) {*T, R, M*}.

The Quran says in the scale of the Law of requital - the (good deeds) of the criminals will have no weight, no good result will be formed for them:

25:23	then We will make him turn to dust	فَجَعَلْنَاهُ هَبَاءً مَنْثُورًا
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He-J-D ه ج د

Ibn Faris says that the basic meaning of this root is “to stay put at some place”.

Lata-iful Lagha says this word has opposite meanings.

Raghib says that “الْهَاجِدُ” (*al-haajidu*) means someone who sleeps.

Muheet says “هَجُودٌ” (*hujudn*) means “to sleep in the day” and “هَجُوعٌ” (*hujuh*) means “to sleep at night”.

“الْهَجُودُ” (*al-hujud*), “الْتَهَجُدُ” (*at-tahajjud*): sleeping, as well as wakening {*T*}.

“هَجَّجْتُهُ فَتَهَجَّجْتُ” (*hajjatuhu fatahajjad*): I removed his sleep, or I drove away his sleep so he woke up. (Like

“مَرَّضْتُهُ” (*marraztuhu*) means I removed his sickness, or looked after him {*R*})

The Quran says:

17:79	Waken or stay awake for some part of the night (with the Quran).	وَمِنَ اللَّيْلِ فَتَهَجَّدْ بِهِ
73:2	stand at night but a little part of the night	فَمِنَ اللَّيْلِ إِلاَّ قَلِيلًا

In the early days of the Quranic program, a lot of study, discussion, and planning is required to work out the details. There is a need for education and training the new entrants into the fold of Islam. The program demands total commitment from the pioneers and will require long working hours. In today's world the developed nations work round the clock to keep their supremacy.

“الْهَجْرُ” (*al-hajr*), “الْهَجْرَانُ” (*al-hijraan*): to give something up, to abstain from something, to separate, to cut off, to cut off relations with, or to avoid.

Raghib says the word means “separation” whether it be personal, physical or of the heart.

Ibn Faris says the basic meanings are “to cut off or separation” and “to fasten tightly”.

The Quran says:

73:10	To disengage nicely from them (and be engaged in the building up of your team)	وَاهْجُرْهُمْ هَجْرًا جَمِيلًا
15:85	So overlook with gracious forgiveness	فَاصْفَحِ الصَّفْحَ الْجَمِيلَ

“هَاجِرَاتٌ” (*haajiraat*): bad things, dirty things or talk, things which demean, things which should be given up {T}.

23:67	(The arrogant people) speak evil about it by night	بِهِ سِيمًا تَهْجُرُونَ
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Some say that “تَهْجُرُونَ” (*tahjiroon*) means “to talk nonsense”.

“الْهَجْرَةُ” (*al-hijrah*): to travel from one area to another.

“هَاجَرَ” (*haajar*) is a verb derived from this root.

Azhari says that for the desert dwellers to transfer to the cities, was called “المُهَاجِرَةُ” (*al-muhaajirah*). Then a man who gives up his residence and goes and resides in another place was called “مُهَاجِرٌ” (*muhaajir*) {T}.

The Quran has used it in particular meaning. According to the Quran a messenger’s duty or a *momin’s* duty in life is to establish the system of Allah on earth. He begins with the place he resides in, but if he sees that the atmosphere there is not conducive then he should not stop his efforts. Instead he should leave that place and migrate to some other place where the atmosphere is conducive to his struggle. A *momin* cannot remain attached to a particular land as the earth belongs to Allah and the *momin* is a right heir. His world is everywhere, he is not born to live and die at a particular place; he is born to establish Allah’s *Deen*. For this purpose he gives up readily whatever he has e.g. wealth, grandeur, power, relatives, country, etc. Giving up all this is called “هَجْرَةٌ” (*hajrah*), and one who does so is called “مُهَاجِرٌ” (*muhaajir*). But this does not mean that he just gives up, but he keeps struggling even after giving, in order to achieve this goal.

The Quran says:

2:218	giving up is also part of the struggle	هَاجِرُونَ وَ جَاهِدُونَ
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“هَاجِرَةٌ” (*hijrat*) or “migration” is not the name for escape from difficulties. This means “to shift to a conducive atmosphere for attaining one’s purpose” (that of establishing God’s *Deen* (system of life) on earth).

The Quran says:

25:30	And the messenger will say before God: O, my Sustainer, my nation has turned the Quran into a “مَهْجُورٌ” <i>mahjur</i> (gave up)	وَقَالَ الرَّسُولُ يَا رَبِّ إِنَّ قَوْمِي اتَّخَذُوا هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ مَهْجُورًا
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Generally it is taken to mean “given up”, but “مَهْجُورٌ” (*mahjur*) has a deeper meaning. A cow that is wont to run away has a rope fettered at one end to a hind leg and the other end to a horn or the neck but the rope is kept tight so that the animal’s head is taut or bent. The animal is thus tethered so tightly that it

cannot take even one step freely (and cannot thus run away). An animal tied this way is called “مَهْجُورٌ” (*mahjur*), and “الْبَجَارُ” (*al-hijaar*) is the rope which is used to thus fasten the animal {T}.

The messenger of Allah will appeal to Allah that the Muslims had left the Quran (left abiding by it) and turned it into a “مَهْجُورٌ” (*mahjur*) of self-created ideas, beliefs, thoughts, customs, traditions, laws, values, etc. without which man could not lift even one step freely. They had not really given up the Quran, but had usurped all the independence it had granted, and it was only allowed to move only so far as the rope of their self-created religion allowed them to move and the Quran was made subservient to these self created chains. This is the real meaning of making the Quran “مَهْجُورٌ” (*mahjur*).

Ibn Qateebah says “بُجْرٌ” (*hujr*) also means “to talk crazy” {*Al-qartain*}. Thus the above verse would mean that they had turned the Quran into some sort of “mantra”.

He-J-Ain ه ج ع

“الْبُجُورُ” (*al-hujuh*): sleep at any time but especially at night. Sometimes it means “not to sleep but just to rest”.

“النَّهْجَاغُ” (*an-nahjaa*): nap.

“رَجُلٌ بُجَعٌ” (*rajulun huja'a*): a foolish, happy-go-lucky, ignorant, and carefree person {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

51:17	He used to sleep very little at night	كَانُوا قَلِيلًا مِّنَ اللَّيْلِ مَا يَهْجَعُونَ
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This is in reference to the preparation for the great change the messenger was to bring and the work which he had taken upon himself in the light of the Quranic guidance. He was willingly engaged day and night and spent a little time at night in sleep (73:4).

He-D-D ه د ذ

“الْبُدُّ” (*al-hudd*): to drop something very hard with a sound, to demolish.

“الْبَادُّ” (*al-haad*): the sound of the sea which to those at the coast sounds like a boom, and sometimes this sound is the precursor of an earthquake.

“الْبَادَّةُ” (*al-haad'dah*): boom (of the clouds) {T, M}.

“الْبِدَّةُ” (*al-huddah*): the sound of something falling.

“بَدَّدْتُ الْبَقَرَةَ” (*haddat tul-baqrah*): I threw the cow on the ground to slaughter it.

“الْبِدُّ” (*al-hidd*): that which has fallen {R}.

“بَدَّدَهُ تَهْدِيدًا” (*hadadahu tahdeedah*): he threatened him and made him frightful {T, M}.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:90	the mountains will fall loudly and be torn to pieces	وَنَحْنُ الْجِبَالُ هَدًا
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“الْبُدُّ” (*al-hudhud*): the pigeon who makes a lot of noise, or any bird which speaks too much. It also means a particular bird {T, M, R}.

The “بُدُّدٌ” (*hudhud*) mentioned in the tale of *Suleman* was an officer of his army (27:20). In those days men and even tribes were named after birds. This continues till today among the Christians. The names Fox and Lamb can still be found in abundance. Even among the Hindus names like *Tota* (parrot) and *Chuhamal* (rat) are still found. The *Lissan-ul-Arab* says that “بَدَائِدُ” (*hadahid*) was the name of a Yemeni tribe.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that “بَدَدٌ” (*hadad*) was the name of a king of *Hameer* who was a contemporary of *Suleman*.

“الْهُدُودُ” (*al-hud hud*) in the Quran has appeared along with “ا” (*alif*) and “ل” (*laam*). This leads one to think that this was not the name of a man, but he was so called in respect of his tribe.

He-D-M ه د م

“الْهَدْمُ” (*al-hadm*): to demolish a building.
 “التَّهْدِيمُ” (*at-tahdeem*) also means the same as above, but it contains a lot of intensity.
 “الْهَدْمُ” (*al-hadm*): to break the back.
 “الْهَدَامُ” (*al-hudaam*): sea sickness.
 “إِنْهَادَ الْبِنَاءِ” (*inhadamal bina’u*): the building fell down.
 “تَهْدَمُ الْبِنَاءِ” (*tahaddamal bina’u*): the building fell down little by little.
 “يَمَازُؤُهُمْ هَدَامٌ” (*dima’uhum hadam*): their blood got wasted {*T, R*}. In (22:40) the places of worship are demolished or may also mean desecrated.

He-D-He-D ه د ه د

For “الْهُدُودُ” (*al-hudhud*), see heading (*He-D-D*).

He-D-Y ه د ي

“هُدًى” (*huda*) basically means “to be prominent and light up”, and “to be in the forefront” and “to lead others”.

“هُدًى” (*huda*): the day.

“هَادِيَةٌ” (*haadiyah*): raised rock which can be seen from afar at sea {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

20:128	Was it not made evident, and clear to them?	أَفَلَمْ يَهْدِ لَهُمْ
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Ibn Faris says it has two basic meanings as “to go ahead in order to show the way” and “to send a gift”.

“هَادٍ” (*haad*) was actually “هَادِي” (*haadi*) and means “the front part of something” because it can be seen from afar first. The neck of animals is called “الْهَادِي” (*al-haadi*) because it is in front, in relation to rest of the body.

“هُدًى” (*hudyun*) and “هَادِيٌ” (*haadiyun*): the animal which was taken to the *kabah* for slaughter during *Hajj*, because that animal was kept in front.

“هَدِيَّةٌ” (*hadiyyah*): a gift, i.e. something which is given without expecting the return or payment for anything. It is given in such a way that it reaches there earlier than when it is actually needed.

“هَدًى” (*hada*): to make the way familiar, to make it evident, to guide {*T, M*}.

Sometimes “هُدًى” (*hada*) means the guide himself as in “أَوَّاجِدُ عَلَى النَّارِ هُدًى” (*au-ajidu alan naari huda*) (20:11){*T*}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:196	The animal which is slaughtered at the time of <i>Hajj</i> in Mecca.	حَتَّىٰ يَبْلُغَ الْهَدْيُ مَحَلَّهُ
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All types of goods that are sent there.

“هَدِيَّةٌ” (*hadiyyah*): gift (27:35).

“هَادٍ” (*haad*): guide, beacon (13:7).

(*muhtad*): he who has received guidance (57:26).

Deen is based on this basic fact that the human intellect cannot formulate the permanent values nor reveal them and as a consequence cannot achieve required self-development. These values are received from Allah and the guidance is called the revelation (The Quran). The Quran was revealed to the Messenger **Muhammed** and is a complete book of guidance i.e. what is required by mankind for all times is within the book. Human intellect needs the Quran just as the human's eye needs the light of the sun (in order to see). If human life is lived under the guidance of the Quran, then the present life on earth will become a heavenly life. Otherwise it will be chaotic and hellish and the mutual conflicts will continue and will never get resolved. This guidance of the Quran is called the guidance from God which takes man towards the balanced way of life.

2:120	Indeed, this guidance of Allah is the only guidance	إِنَّ هُدَى اللَّهِ هُوَ الْهُدَى
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As against it, the guidance devised by human beings is not guidance but waywardness (2:16). This is the right path and all other are wrong paths(3:7). The messengers came into this world with this Divine guidance, but they were responsible only to make the people aware of this guidance, not to make the people follow the right way (28:56, 2:272). Man can traverse the right path only out of his own will. He cannot be forced by anyone to traverse this path, because there is no coercion in **Deen** (2:256).

Allah Himself has made the path bright and evident for humans. He has not created them so that they follow only the right path automatically:

76:3	we have made the road evident for him: he can either adopt it or reject it	إِنَّا هَدَيْنَاهُ السَّبِيلَ إِمَّا شَاكِرًا وَإِمَّا كَفُورًا
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The word guidance itself testifies to the fact that there is no coercion in this matter. The way is shown only to those who want to undertake the journey to reach the destination and want to avoid the difficulties of being misled. These people are called **muttaqeen**. The Quran has called itself “بُذَى لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ” (**hudal lil muttaqeen**) in this sense (2:2) i.e. “those who want to avoid the wrong path, it is guidance for them to the right path”.

He-R-B ه ر ب

“هَرَبَ” (**herb**), “يَهْرُبُ” (**yahrub**), “هَرَبًا” (**haraba**): he ran away.
 “هَرَبَ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (**haraba fil ard**): he went far on this earth.
 “هَرَبَهُ” (**harrabahu**): he made some other man run away.
 “هَرَبَ مِنَ الْوَتْدِ نِصْفَهُ” (**haraba minal watadi nisfihu**): the peg was pushed halfway.
 “أَهْرَبَ فُلَانٌ” (**ahraba fulaan**): that man was engaged in that matter, immersed in that matter.
 “أَهْرَبَتِ الرِّيحُ” (**ahrabatir reeh**): the wind blew the dust {**T, R**}.
 “هَرَبَ” (**harab**), “يَهْرُبُ” (**yahrab**): he went far (a distance) on land {**M**}.

The Quran says:

72:12	And we think that we cannot defeat Allah by running away or escaping (we cannot defeat him by running away from the Law of equital)	وَأَنَّا ظَنَنَّا أَن لَّنْ نُّعْجِزَ اللَّهَ فِي الْأَرْضِ وَلَنِ نُّعْجِزَهُ هَرَبًا
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“الْبَرْغُ” (*al-hara*), “الْإِبْرَاحُ” (*al-ihraa*): to drive harshly, to make run fast {T, R}.

“بَرَعَ إِلَيْهِ” (*hara-i ilaih*): reach him eagerly and speedily.

“الْإِبْرَاحُ” (*al-ihraa*): the intensity of eagerness.

“الْمُبْرَغُ” (*al-muhri*): lion {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is “movement” and “tribulation”.

Uhrir Rajul says it means “he trembled with fear”.

“أُبْرِغَ الرَّجُلُ” (*hum yuhra-oona ilaih*): they came to him in droves.

The Quran says about the nation of *Luut*:

11:78	His nation came towards him running with eagerness	هُمْ يُهْرَعُونَ إِلَيْهِ
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“يُهْرَعُونَ” (*yuhra-oon*) includes the intensity of eagerness and fervent-ness. This one word, therefore, depicts their real emotional state.

“يُهْرَعُونَ” (*yuhra-oon*): their emotions were instigating them to do so.

“بَزِيَءٌ” (*hazeeyun*), “بَزُوًا” (*hazwa*), “بَزُوَاءٌ” (*huzuwan*) and “بَزُوَا” (*huzuwa*) mean “make fun of”.

“رَجُلٌ بَزْءٌ” (*rajulun huz’ah*): a man who is made fun of by people, laughing stock.

“مَفَازَةٌ بَازِءَةٌ بِالرَّكْبِ” (*mafazatun haazi’atun bir rakb*): a desolate jungle which makes fun of riders (due to whose vastness and awe people are belittled) {T}.

The hypocrites used to tell their party leaders in private that they had told the *muslims* that they had believed, but it was done only jocularly (that there was no sincerity in their words) (2:14).

The Quran says in answer to them that the Law of requital is in fact making fun of these people. They think mirages are for real and struggle to get to them and finally find out that their efforts were useless. For them to be deceived is itself a joke with them. The law of Allah gives them time which allows them to proceed with their wrong ways and make a joke of themselves in a world of reality:

2:14	We are simply mockers	نَحْنُ مُسْتَهْزِئُونَ
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Surah *Al-Hijr* says that the people who think that someone else is also authoritative in the universe beside God or some other law is also at work in this universe, then these people are in way playing a joke on God:

19:95	We are sufficient to deal with on your behalf with the people who worship other idols beside Allah	إِنَّا كَفَيْكَ الْمُسْتَهْزِئِينَ الَّذِينَ يَجْعَلُونَ مَعَ اللَّهِ إِلَهًا آخَرَ
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This makes it very clear that “to joke with Allah” means to share His stature with others, or to take the concept of God lightly, and not to reflect on the realities of life seriously.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:67	They asked “are you joking with us?”	قَالُوا أَتَتَّخِذُنَا هُزُوًا
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“هَزَّ” (*hazzah*), “يَهْزُهُ” (*yahuzuhu*), “هَزَّأَ” (*hazza*): to move something (either by pulling, by pushing, or by moving to the right or left).

Raghib says that “هَزَّ” (*hazun*) means “to move with intensity, to move violently” {*T, R*}.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:25	move it hard towards yourself	وَهَزَّ إِلَيْكَ
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“هَزَّ الْحَادِي إِبْلًا هَزَّأَ” (*hazzal haadi il ibla hazza*): the *haddi* maker made the camels pleased with his *haddi*, therefore they became happy and started walking lightly.

“الْهَزَّةُ” (*al-hizzah*): stupor (which makes man swoon with happiness).

“إِهْتَزَّتْ النَّبَاتُ” (*ihazzun nabaat*): plants began to swoon in the wind {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

22:5	when We make it rain then the plants swoon (due to the rain)	فَإِذَا أَنْزَلْنَا عَلَيْهَا الْمَاءَ اهْتَزَّتْ
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At another place this word has been used opposite “خَاشِعَةً” (*khaashiah*) which means “downcast” (41:39).

“الْهَزْلُ” (*al-hazl*): not to take some issue seriously, i.e. take it jocularly or lightly.

“هَزِيلٌ” (*hizzil*): one who jokes a lot.

“الْهَزَالَةُ” (*al-huzaalah*): joke.

“الْهَزَالُ” (*al-huzaal*): weakness {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “feebleness”.

Raghib says that “الْهَزْلُ” (*al-hazl*) means everything which has no use or which is of no consequence (not important) {*R*}.

The Quran says about itself:

86:14	This is a decisive reality, not just something for amusement.	إِنَّهُ لَقَوْلٌ فَصْلٌ وَمَاهُوَ بِالْهَزْلِ
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The Quran discusses the realities of human living and needs careful and serious attention. Every word in it must be very seriously deliberated upon. These should not be taken lightly nor must it be thought that these contain only advice. The Quran is a proven reality. Whatever is said in it is a fact not just make-believe or something to frighten. It answers all the possible questions which all human beings for all times can possibly think e.g. the purpose of their creation, the issues of their lives, interaction, death, their thinking and the related issues, the permanent values, the concept and attributes of Allah, human weaknesses and strengths, etc.

“هَزَمَ” (*hazm*): to press a dry thing to breaking point {*R*}. Later the word came to mean break {*T*}.

“تَهَزَّامَتِ الْقَوْسُ” (*tahazzamatil qaus*): the bow broke with a loud noise.

“الْهَزِيمُ” (*al-hareem*): boom with a cutting edge in it.

“هَزَمَ الْعَدُوَّ” (*hazamal aduwu*): defeated enemy {*R*} (2:251).

“جُنْدٌ...مَهْزُومٌ” (*jundun...mahzoom*): defeated army (38:11).

Surah *Al-Qamar* says:

54:45	this party will be defeated	سَيُهْزَمُ الْجَمْعُ
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He-Sh-Sh ه ش ش

“هَشُّ” (*hash*): to move. It is close to the meaning of “هَزُّ” (*hazza*) and is generally said for soft things, like moving leaves etc. {*R*}.

“هَشُّ الْوَرَقِ” (*hushal waraq*): to shed leaves from the trees {*Ibn Faris*}.

It also means “to be happy”.

“أَنَا بِي هَشُّنْ بَشُّنْ” (*ana bihi hush-un bash-un*): I am very happy with him.

“الْهَشِيشُ” (*al-hasheesh*): a philanthropist who is very happy when someone asks him for something {*T*}.

Surah *Taha* says that when *Moosa* received the revelation, Allah asked him about his opinion about the message and he replied it will support him and guide him throughout his life.

20:18	through this I will create nutrition for the soul of my flock of sheep (<i>the Bani Israel</i>)	أَهْشُّ بِهَا عَلَى عَنَمِي
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The literal meaning of this verse is “with this (staff) I bring down (shed) the leaves of trees for my flock of sheep”.

He-Sh-M ه ش م

“الْهَشْمُ” (*al-hashm*): to break a dry thing or to break anything that is not difficult to break.

“الْهَشِيمُ” (*al-hasheem*): broken, the grass which has dried and broken into little pieces (like sawdust), dry grass or trees {*T, R, M*}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:45	It becomes dry (brittle) and breaks into small pieces	فَأَصْبَحَ هَشِيمًا
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Surah *Al-Qamar* says:

54:31	It became rubbish like the rubbish which falls off a fencer's fence (totally useless, or waste)	فَكَانُوا كَهَشِيمِ الْمُحْتَظِرِ
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“تَهَشَّمَ النَّاقَةُ” (*tahash shaman naaqah*): he milked the camel with his full hand (milked the teats dry).

“هَاشِمٌ” (*haashim*): someone who breaks bread or one who breaks it into small pieces. It was the title for *Umr-ul-Ala* who was the father of *Abdul Muttalib* because he used to make caps for the pilgrims to earn his living. Hence it means “to put broken pieces of bread into the curry, or have a mouthful”.

“الْهَشِيمُ” (*al-hashim*): a philanthropist.

“الْهَشْمُ” (*al-hashm*): low, dry, land {*T, M, R*}.

He-Zd-M ه ض م

“هَضَمَ” (*hazm*): to trample or break a soft thing, to reduce something.

“هَضَمَ فُلَانًا” (*hazama fulana*): he oppressed that man, oppressed him and usurped his rights.

“الْهَضَامُ” (*al-hazzaam*): lion.

“هَضَمَهُ حَقًّا” (*hazamahu haqqahu*): he reduced his right.

“الْهَضِيمُ” (*al-hazeem*): soft, fine, solid, delightful, a thing which has penetrated another thing partly {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris says these are its basic meanings.

The Quran says:

20:112	Then he shall not fear any injustice or deprivation.	فَلَا يَخَافُ ظُلْمًا وَلَا هَضْمًا
26:14	Whose flowers are laid on top of one another and which penetrate each other	طَلَعَهَا هَضِيمٌ

He-T-Ain ه ط ع

“هَطُوعًا” (*hata’a*), “هَطَعًا” (*hatan*) and “هَطُوعًا” (*hutu’a*): to move fast, and fearfully towards something, or to move towards something with the gaze fixed on it and unwavering. “أَهْطَعَ” (*ahta’a*) also means this.

“أَهْطَعَ الْبَعِيرُ فِي سَيْرِهِ” (*ahta’al ba-eeru fi sairih*): camel straightened his head and stretched his neck while walking {T, M, R}.

The Quran has depicted the harassment during battle and said “مُهْطِعِينَ” (*muhti-een*) (14:43) which means people will be so frightened that they will not be aware of the whereabouts. They will be fearful and running straight (without being aware what is to the left or the right) {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris says it has the connotation of facing something, moving towards something, to obey and follow something.

Hal هَلْ

This word appears to ask something:

18:103	Do you want Me to tell you about the people whose deeds will make go wasted?	هَلْ تُبْذِرُكُمْ بِالْأَخْسَرِينَ أَعْمَالًا
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Sometimes it means the same as “قَدْ” (*qad*) which means “verily”.

76:1	Surely, man has been through such long time ...	هَلْ أَتَى عَلَى الْإِنْسَانِ حِينٌ مِّنَ الدَّهْرِ
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In (55:60) the Quran says, ‘Is there any reward for doing good other than good?’ This means the reward for doing good is inbuilt within the deed itself i.e. one gets further self-development by doing good to others.

He-L-Ain ه ل ع

“أَلْهَعُ” (*al-hala’u*): tribulation, impatience, too much, to cross the limit, and the worst kind of fretting, sadness and gloom.

“أَلْهَوُوعٌ” (*al-haluh*): greedy and extremely miserly, narrow minded, one who displays impatience.

“هَلَعَ” (*halia*), “يَهْلَعُ” (*yahla’a*): he became hungry {T, M}.

When a man is greedy, as well as hungry, then a situation is created that the greed doesn’t subside even if a lot is eaten and he keeps wailing about it being not enough.

Ibnas Sakeet says that “رَجُلٌ يَلْعَهُ” (*rajulun hal’atah*) means a man who loses patience and hope quickly and cries out in desperation {F}.

The Quran says:

70:20	if man is left to his own devices then his greed is never satiated	إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ خُلِقَ هَلُوعًا
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It is only the system of *salaat* which creates satiation in him and removes his wailing of insufficiency (70:22). The Quran helps us change our thinking towards the good of mankind and thus moves us away from our selfish desires (28:50).

ه ل ك He-L-K

“هَلَكَ” (*halak*), “يَهْلِكُ” (*yahlik*): to die, although the people use it to mean “a bad death” {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to break and fall.

Raghib says that “هَلَاكَ” (*halaak*) means punishment, fear, and poverty.

“اسْتَهْلَكَ الْمَالُ” (*istahlak al-maal*): the wealth was squandered away, the draught years.

“أَهْلَكَ الْمَالُ” (*al-hullaak al-maal*): . He sold his produce/things.

“أَهْلَاكَ” (*al-hallak*): poor, helpless people, or those who go on a journey to get help but instead get lost.

“أَهْلَالِكُمْ” (*al-haalikah*): greedy self.

“أَتَهْلِكُكُمْ” (*at-tahlukah*): anything which ultimately leads to destruction {T, M}.

Raghib says it means “for something not to stay with someone” and “for something to go bad” or “to die” or “for something to be wasted”.

The Quran has mentioned the fall of nations (or civilisations). There is no doubt that in ancient times some dwellings may have been completely destroyed by a natural calamity, as earthquake, or volcanic eruption, but generally fall of nations means their ignominy and weakness and subjugation, i.e. if some nation enjoys good standing then its falling from this position is akin to its destruction.

This is the destruction about which the Quran says:

2:195	Keep your wealth open (available) for the system of Allah. If you do not do this then you will yourself bring annihilation unto yourselves.	وَأَنْفِقُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَلَا تُلْقُوا بِأَيْدِيكُمْ إِلَى التَّهْلُكَةِ
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Sometimes a nation suffers due to some natural calamity, but as soon as the calamity is over it recovers.

This is called its renaissance or new life or “نَشْأَةٌ ثَانِيَةٌ” (*nishaat-i-saaniah*), as has been said in the story of **Bani-Israel**:

2:56	We gave you new life after your death	ثُمَّ بَعَثْنَاكُمْ مِنْ بَعْدِ مَوْتِكُمْ
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In Surah **Al-Isra** the first condition has been described as “punishment” and the second condition as “annihilation” (17:58, 21:95), but this is not a rule. There are exceptions to this.

Surah **Al-Qasas** says:

28:88	It is taken to mean that the entire universe will be destroyed and only God will stay intact	كُلُّ شَيْءٍ هَالِكٌ إِلَّا وَجْهَهُ
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In support of this meaning, the following verse of Surah **Ar-Rahman** is presented:

55:26	Everyone who is on it, shall perish.	كُلُّ مَنْ عَلَيْهَا فَانٍ
55:27	But the face or the Sustainer shall remain who is the owner of the Majesty and Honour.	وَيَبْقَىٰ وَجْهُ رَبِّكَ ذُو الْجَلَالِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ

But this is not the right meaning of these verses (and the words) (55:27)

“هَالِكٌ” (*haalik*) in the first verse and “فَانٍ” (*faani*) are both noun-verbs, and till noun verbs are specifically linked to the future, they reflect the present i.e. as it is happening now. For instance, “إِنِّي جَاعِلٌ” (*inni ja'ilun*) does not mean “I will make”, but rather “I am making it”. As such, “هَالِكٌ” (*haalik*) and “فَانٍ” (*faani*) do not mean that “this universe will one day come to an end” {T}. It means that (the termination)

is taking place now . Everything in the universe is going towards its termination. Termination does not mean “to be obliterated”, but “to undergo change”, i.e. not “to stay in the same condition”. “بلاكت” (*halakaat*) (i.e death) too means “for the force (power, strength, energy) to be reduced”, therefore this verse means that “nothing in the universe remains in the same state”. That is, “it undergoes change every moment in time”. There are changes in things which take place all the while. Their strength or force is reduced every moment, but the universal law of Allah which leads to universal development, is unchanging. It is safe from the effects of any change. This is what permanent value means. Therefore this verse means that everything in the universe is subject to change, excepting the permanent values which are determined according to the laws of Allah (as noted in the Quran), and which result in universal development, or in Allah’s sustenance. Therefore, the ideology, the system of life, the nation which can be safe from such change, is that which adheres itself to the permanent values. The nation which does not do so, is bound to be weakened in its strength till it is eliminated completely.

Surah *Al-Haqqah* says:

69:29	My power was gradually lost, my strength gradually turned into weakness.	هَلَكْتُ عَنْ سُلْطَانِيَّةٍ
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In the verses quoted above, the reference to “*wajha rab*” (55:27) may also mean Allah {T}.

What will be end of the universe is a mystery as much as the beginning of the universe is – this question does cross our mind as we go through our life. At our present level of understanding we cannot fully comprehend these matters. However, we know that God has created the universe and it is sustained according to His laws and the universe will end according to His laws as well. The universe is not permanent, i.e. not permanent like the permanence of the existence of God. For us, it is also a futile thing to worry about as to what will be the end of the universe, because we have to depart from this present life one day anyway – our life’s timescale is tiny as compared to the age of the universe. The best thing for us to do is to add to the world’s beauty while living within the permanent values as long as we live in this life.

He-L-L ل ل ل

“إِهْلَالٌ” (*ihlaal*) actually means “to raise the voice” {T}.

Raghib says it was a high sound that was made at the sighting of the new moon. Later it was used to make any sound {R}.

“هَلَّلَ الرَّجُلُ” (*hullar rajul*): the man screamed.

“اسْتَهْلَلَ الصَّبِيُّ” (*istahalas sabiyu*): the child started crying as soon as it was born.

“أَهْلَالٌ” (*al-hilaal*): the first and second day of the moon. Some say that it is also used to mean even the third day or up to the seventh day of the moon (also referred to the 26th / 27th night of the moon in a lunar calendar).

“هَلَّلَ” (*hilaal*): new moon, because when people sight the moon they announce to others about it {T}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “to raise the voice”.

“أَهْلَلَ الشَّيْرُ” (*ahlash shajr*): sighted the moon for the month {T}.

“أَهْلَالٌ” (*al-halaal*) and “أَهْلَالٌ” (*al-hilaal*): the first rain but a rain which falls with a sound {T}.

“أَهْلَالٌ” (*al-halal*): the brain of an elephant about which it is said that is veritable poison {T}.

“هَلَّلَ” (*hallal*): the Jews and the Christians recite this word while reciting the beads which is a Hebrew and Syrian word {M}.

“هَلَّلَ” (*hallal*): to say as we say لا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ” (*ilaaha illal laah*) {M}.

The Quran says in respect of forbidden things:

2:173	Anything which is sacrificed or given in a name other than Allah’s	وَمَا أَهْلًا بِهِ لَعَبْرَ اللَّهِ
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As per the Quran anything which is dedicated to anyone else other than Allah, is forbidden. According to the Quran any other concept (the idol) except Allah is shirk for a *momin*. This aspect needs to be understood as to why this prohibition has been detailed in the Quran. For example a sheep is a permitted animal for human consumption, but since it has been dedicated to someone other than Allah, it becomes forbidden. Similarly when it is said that this food is “*niyaaz*” or “dedicated to” so and so, then the food, although it is pure and permitted, becomes forbidden because it has been dedicated to other than Allah. Because “*shirk*” is reflected in such a dedication, it is against the concept of “the oneness of Allah”. The Iman as defined in the Quran deals with human thinking where beliefs and concepts are formed which ultimately direct our physical self to carry out daily living (2:177). Whatever we do, is preceded by our thoughts and these decisions manifest themselves as visible acts. The acceptance of any deity other than Allah at a thinking level means that our thought process has been affected and which in the long run will divert us from the righteous path. The Quran is the book which deals with the human thought process which precedes our decision and any ‘contamination’ at this level will lead to influencing our Iman. This will compromise our conduct in real life and we will not be able to carry out the righteous deeds within the domain of the permanent values and will fail to establish a system based on these values.

The Quran wants to keep man’s beliefs free from any shadow of “*shirk*”, because “*shirk*” leads to the downgrading of human self which possesses free will.

Halam

هَلُمَّ

“هَلُمَّ” (*hallum*): to come.

“هَلُمَّ إِلَيْنَا” (*halluma ilaina*): come to us, bring to us.

“هَلُمَّ شُهَدَاءَكُمْ” (*hallum shuda’akum*): bring your witnesses (6:151).

Hoom

هُمَّ

“هُمَّ” (*hoom*) signify the plural third person agency towards which an action is directed.

“هُمَّ رِجَالٌ” (*hoom rijaalun*): they are all men.

“هُمُ الَّذِينَ يَقُولُونَ” (*humullazeena yaqulun*): they are the ones who say (63:7)

“ضَرَبَهُمْ” (*zarabahum*): he thrashed all of them.

“ثُمَّ عَرَضَهُمْ عَلَى الْمَلَائِكَةِ” (*summa a’ra zuhum a’la al-mala’ikah*): then they were presented to the *malaaiakah* (2:31)

“غُلَامَهُمْ” (*ghulamuhum*): slave to all of them.

“حَبَا لَهُمْ وَعَصِيُّهُمْ” (*hibaalahum wa isiyyuhum*): their ropes and their sticks.... (20:66)

Huma

هُمَا

“هُمَا رَجُلَانِ” (*huma rajulaan*): they are both men.

“هُمَا امْرَأَتَانِ” (*huma imra’ataan*): both are women.

“إِذْ هُمَا فِي الْغَارِ” (*iz huma fil ghaar*): when both were in the cave (9:40)

“ضَرَبَهُمَا” (*zarabuhuma*): he beat both of them.

“فَأَزَلَّهُمَا الشَّيْطَانُ” (*fa’azal la humash shaitaan*): so *shaitaan* induced both of them... (2:36).

“غُلَامَهُمَا” (*ghulamahuma*): the slaves of both. This is for masculine as well as feminine.

“بِسِحْرِهِمَا” (*bi-sihrihima*): (these two) due to their sorcery (20:63).

He-M-D

ه م د

“الْهُمُودُ” (*al-humud*): for the fire to be extinguished.
 “خَمَدَتِ النَّارُ” (*khamaditan naar*) is said when flames of a fire die out.
 “هَمَدَتْ هُمُودًا” (*hamadat humuda*) is said when flames die out completely.
 “هَبَّابُهُنَّ” (*haba yahbu*): it is said when a fire turns into ashes.
 “الْهُمُودُ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*al-humudu fil ard*): for life to be extinguished from the earth, i.e. for it to be minus vegetation and for no rain to fall in it {*T*}.

The Quran says:

22:5	you find the land dead where there is no sign of life	وَتَرَى الْأَرْضَ هَامِدَةً
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“يَمَرُ الْمَاءُ يَمْرُهُ” (*hamaral ma’a yah’mirhu*): he spilled the water, or dropped it.

“يَمَرُ الدَّمْعُ” (*haarad dam’a*): he shed tears.

“إِنهَمَرَ الدَّمْعُ وَالْمَطَرُ” (*inhamarad dam’u wal matar*): tears and rain flowed.

“الْهَمَارُ” (*al-hammaar*): a cloud which rains profusely {T}.

“الْهَمَزُ” (*al-hamz*): to pinch, to push and beat, to bite.

“الْهَامِيزُ” (*al-haamizu*): one who pinches, who creates division in the party, one who creates division among friends, one who indulges in back-bite. This meaning with exaggeration is of “الْهَمْزَةُ” (*al-hoomzah*).

“الْمِهْمَازُ” (*al-mihmaz*), “الْمِهْمَازُ” (*al-mihmaaz*): a pointed thing made of iron, a sort of spike which is fixed to a rider’s boot which he uses to spur the animal {T, M}.

Raghib says that “الْهَمَزُ” (*al-hamz*) means to wring or back-bite {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says its basic meaning is to press or wring.

“هُمَزَةٌ” (*hoomzah*) and “هَمَّازٌ” (*hammaaz*): one who finds faults.

Surah **Al-Mominoon** says:

23:97	All the schemes of the opponents with which they plan to create division among the momineen	هُمَزَاتِ الشَّيْطَانِ
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Surah **Al-Qalam** says:

68:11	Defamer	هَمَّازٍ
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Surah **Al-Humazah** says “هُمَزَةٌ” (*humazah*) in (104:1). The meaning of the word is the same in every place i.e. “those who create or intend to create division with their machinations”.

Maulana Abeedullah Sindhi says that it means “a person who perceives the darker side of everything and who finds fault with everyone’s work and has no appreciation for any of the good things in the universe, or appreciates any good work”. For example, this is a capitalist mentality. A capitalist thinks, because he has so much wealth and he possesses all the good things of the world, and whoever is poor in comparison possesses no quality {**Al-maqamal Mahmood**}.

“الْهَمْسُ” (*al-hams*): secret voice, a slight sound of a tread.

“الْهَمِيسُ” (*al-hamees*): the sound of the camel’s tread {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

20:108	you will not hear anything but a faint murmur.	لَا تَسْمَعُ إِلَّا هَمْسًا
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“الْهَمْسُ” (*al-hams*): to chew food with the mouth closed so that no sound emits. It also means “to wring, to beat forcibly and repeatedly”.

“الْمُهَامَسَةُ” (*al-muhamasa*): for a group to murmur quietly among themselves {T, M, R}.

Ibn Faris says “هَمٌّ” (*hum*) word basically means “to melt”, “to flow” and “crawl slowly”.

“أَلْهَمٌ” (*al-hum*): sadness and sorrow.

“هَمٌّ” (*hum*) and “غَمٌّ” (*gham*) differ in that “غَمٌّ” (*gham*) is the feeling of sadness that is produced after some event has taken place, and “هَمٌّ” (*hum*) is the pain which one experiences at the thought of some catastrophe which is about to take place {T}.

“هَمَّهُ” (*hammahu*) and “أَهَمَّهُ” (*ahammah*): made him sad and restless.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:153	A party that is disturbed by its own thoughts	وَمَا أَتَيْنَاهُمْ إِلَّا أَنفُسُهُمْ
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Here the meaning is that the people of this group were not actually experiencing some misery, but they were being troubled by the thought of what could happen.

“أَلْهَمٌ” (*al-humm*): to intend to do something, to resolve to do something {T}.

“هَمَّ بِالشَّيْءِ” (*humma bish shaiyi*): intended to do something but did not actually do it {M}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:24	The governors's wife decided (in her heart) to entice <i>Yusuf</i> and maybe <i>Yusuf</i> would have become inclined too if Allah's thought had not come clearly before him	وَلَقَدْ هَمَّتْ بِهِ وَهَمَّ بِهَا لَوْلَا أَنَّ رَأْيَهَا رَئِيَ رَبِّهِ
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The governors's wife only had her passion before her and nothing else that would stop her from her evil intentions, but *Yusuf* had Allah's thought that prevented him from going along with her desire. Whenever there is a tie between human desire and a permanent value, then a *momin* sacrifices human desire in favour of the permanent value. This is what belief in the permanent values means.

Surah *Al-Momin* says:

40:5	Every nation tried or made schemes to hurt their messenger, or intended to	وَهَمَّتْ كُلُّ أُمَّةٍ بِرَسُولِهِمْ لِيَأْخُذُوهُ
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“أَلْهَمٌ” (*al-himmah*): a deed for which firm intent is made, firm intent, beginning of intent {T}.

“أَلْمُهِمَّاتُ مِنَ الْأُمُورِ” (*al-muhimmaatu minal umur*): very important matters {T}.

“هَنَا” (*huna*), “هَاهُنَا” (*hahuna*): here, at this place.

“إِنَّا هَاهُنَا قَاعِدُونَ” (*inna hahuna qaa'idoon*): we are seated here (5:24, 69:35).

“هُنَالِكَ” (*hunalik*): there.

“هُنَالِكَ دَعَا زَكَرِيَّا” (*hunalika da'a zakariyya*): *Zakaraiyya* called out there (3:37).

33:11	The time came to call out the <i>Momineen</i> there	هُنَالِكَ ابْتُلِيَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ
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“الْهَيْئَةُ” (*al-hani'u*): anything in possessing which there is no harm and which has no bad effect. This word is used to mean “food” although it is also used for other things {R}.

“طَعَامٌ هَنِئٌ” (*ta'aamun haniyun*): delightful food.

“التَّهْنِئَةُ” (*at-tahni'ah*): against the law, to congratulate {T}.

Surah *An-Nisa'a* says:

4:4	Eat it happily (bring it readily to use)	فَكُلُوهُ هَنِيئًا مَرِيئًا
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“هُنَّ نِسَاءٌ” (*hunna nisatun*): they are all women.

“ضَرَبَهُنَّ” (*zarabahunna*): he thrashed all those women.

“غُلَامُهُنَّ” (*ghulamuhunna*): the slave of all those women.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:187	They are like clothing for you	هُنَّ لِبَاسٌ لَّكُمْ
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Surah *An-Nisa* says:

4:25	Bring them into <i>nikaah</i> with the permission of their owners and give them their <i>Mehar</i>	فَأَنْكِحُوهُنَّ بِإِذْنِ أَهْلِهِنَّ وَآتُوهُنَّ أَجُورَهُنَّ
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“هُوَ رَجُلٌ” (*huwa rajhulun*): he is a man.

“هُوَ اللَّهُ الَّذِي” (*huwal laahul lazi...*): indeed it is Allah (59:22).

“الْهُودُ” (*al-haud*): to claim to be close towards the truth with ease and facility {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

7:156	We look towards you (refer to you, turn to you)	إِنَّا هُنَّا إِلَيْكَ
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“الْهُودُ” (*al-huud*): Jews {T, M, R}.

“هَادٍ” (*haad*): he became a Jew.

“يَهُودًا” (*yahuda*): it was the name of one of *Yaqoob's* sons {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

2:111	Except those who are Jews	إِلَّا مَنْ كَانَ هُودًا
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Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:69	And the people who became Jews	وَالَّذِينَ هَادُوا
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For details see heading “*Moosa*”.

The nation of *Nouh* was replaced by the nation of *Aad* (7:69). Details can be found under the heading “*Noah*”. Towards this nation, his brother *Hoodh* was sent as a messenger (7: 65). These people were physically very strong and were well built (7:69) and had fertile lands (26:134). They were ahead of the nation of *Noah* in terms of their development and their culture. They used to build very strong forts (26:169) and used to build monuments in mountains (26:128) i.e. technically advanced. They also had knowledge and wisdom (46:26) but were oppressive. They used to hold the poor and the oppressed in their iron grip (26:130).

Hoodh delivered the same message to them that *Nouh* before him had given to his nation, i.e:

7:65	O my nation, bow before Allah's laws. None other than His laws are worth following.	يَقُومُوا لِعِبَادَةِ اللَّهِ مَا لَكُمْ مِنْ إِلَهٍ غَيْرُهُ
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As usual, there was opposition to this message (7:66) and they became so blind in their opposition that their wisdom too did not serve them (46:26) and they had to be destroyed by a destructive storm (41:42) and their roots were uprooted (7:72). The Quran has called this nation as “*Aad*, the first” (53:50).

What was the relationship between nations that were destroyed through natural calamities and their deeds can be found in the book titled *Jooy-i-Noor* under the heading “*Noah*”.

He-W-R

ه و ر

“بَارَ الْبِنَاءَ بُورًا” (*haarat bina'a haura*): he demolished the building.
 “فَهَارَ” (*fahaar*): so it was demolished.
 “إِنْهَارَ” (*inhaar*): to blow up and demolish.
 “وَهُوَ بَارٌّ وَبَارٌ” (*wahuwa haa'iroon wa-haar*), “تَهَوَّرَ” (*tahawwar*): he was demolished.
 “تَهَوَّرَ” (*tahawwur*): for something to fall into the pond or well.
 “تَهَوَّرَ الرَّجُلُ” (*tahawwarar rajul*): the man entered the situation without thinking, i.e. fell into it like the banks of a river cave in suddenly {T, M, R}.
 “تَهَوَّرَ” (*tahawwur*): the edge that falls down {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

9:109	On the edge of a bank that will fall and which can take you down with it	عَلَى شَفَا جُرْفٍ هَارٍ فَأَنْهَارِيهِ
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He-W-N

ه و ن

“هَانَ” (*haan*), “يَهُونُ” (*yahoon*), “هُنَا” (*huna*): to be insulted, demeaned.
 “هَانَا” (*haana*), “هُنَا” (*huna*): to become easy. This word appears for softness and facility and also for insult and demeaning {T}.

Ibn Faris says that it basically means, peace, quiet, and contentment.

Raghib says that when man adopts humility then this humility is commendable, but if some powerful force creates humility in a man forcibly then there is an element of insult in this act, and this is bad {R}.

“هَوَّنَ الشَّيْءَ وَأَبَانَهُ” (*hawwanash shaiya wa'ahanahu*): to consider something as lowly, to demean it.
 “الْهَيِّنُ” (*al-hayyin*): easy.
 “الْهَوَانُ” (*al-hawanu*), “الْمَهَانَةُ” (*al-mahana*): weakness and feebleness, insult and hatred {M}.
 “هَيِّنٌ” (*hayyin*): static and content.
 “إِمْرَأَةٌ هَوْنَةٌ” (*imra'atun haunah*): a content woman who works with dignity and with ease.

“سَارَ عَلَى بَيْنَتِهِ” (*saara ala heenatihi*): as was his habit that he walked softly and with ease.

Surah *An-Nahal* says that when anyone of these desert dwellers is told about the birth of a girl, then his face becomes sad and he tries to avoid facing other people and thinks:

16:59	Should he let the girl (about whose birth he has been given the news) live or bury her out of fear of ignominy or insult	إِمْسِكْهُ عَلَى هُونٍ أَمْ يَدُسُّهُ فِي التُّرَابِ
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These thoughts accompanied the birth of a girl-child at that time and is still prevalent in many cultures across the world.

The Quran says:

25:69	And he will abide forever within, humiliated. (This contains the element of insult and infamy.)	يَخْلُدُ فِيهِ مُهَانًا
19:9	It is easy for me	هُوَ عَلَى هَيْنٍ
24:15	You consider it an insignificant matter although according to the laws of Allah it is a big issue.	تَحْسِبُونَهُ هِينًا وَهُوَ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ عَظِيمٌ
9:16	to weaken in respect and demeaned in respect of sustenance	رَبِّي أَهَانَنِي

Thus wherever in the Quran it is said “عَذَابٌ مُهِينٌ” (*azaabun muheen*), as in (2:90), it means “the punishment which not only demeans but also weakens a nation”. In subjugation, both these two things happen, i.e. “demeaning” and “weakening”. It also means the nations which are dependent on others.

Surah *Al-Furqaan* says about those who follow Allah’s laws:

25:63	They move about in this world with complete equanimity	يَمْشُونَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ هَوْنًا
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It means that there is neither furtiveness nor fear for them, because they are not weakened and demeaned, but are dominant over all (3:138). If this holds a meaning of speed, then this means that they adopt a medium instance and do not preen (31:17-18). If “يَمْشُونَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ” (*yamshuna alal ard*) means “power” and “dominance” in this world then it would mean that their government is not oppressive.

As said earlier, Surah *Al-Fajr* says that when man faces the punishment or shortage in the means of sustenance, then he says “رَبِّي أَهَانَنِي” (*rabbi ahanun*) (89:16) which means “my Sustainer has demeaned me for nothing”.

The Quran says that Allah never demeans anybody for nothing. Every man’s deeds make him successful as well as demeaned. You were demeaned because you had plenty of sustenance but:

89:17	You did not respect those who were left alone in a society	لَا تُكْرِمُونَ الْيَتِيمَ
89:18	and did not encourage others to feed those who suffered some setback.	وَلَا تَحْضُونَ عَلَى طَعَامِ الْمَسْكِينِ
89:19	You used to collect all inheritance and gobble it up, and used to collect wealth from all deirections	وَتَأْكُلُونَ التَّرَاثَ أَكْلًا لَّمًّا

Then the Quran concludes (89:21-22) that due to your such deeds, you are now reaping the consequences of your earlier wrong system which was based on human exploitation.

He-W-Y ھ و ی

“هَوَىٰ” (*hawa*), “يَهْوَىٰ” (*yahwi*), “هَوِيًّا” (*hawiyya*): to fall down from up.

“هَوَى الشَّيْءُ” (*hawashshaiyi*): the thing fell down from above.

“هَوَتْ الْعُقَابُ نَهْوًى هَوِيًّا” (*hawatil uqaabu tahwi huwiyya*): the eagle dived downwards in order to grab its prey.

“الْمَهْوَىٰ” (*al-mahwah*): atmosphere or space, and also the low land between two mountains {*T*}.

“الْهَوِيُّ” (*al-hawiyyu*): ears to ring, the humming sound {*M*}

“هَوَاءٌ” (*hawaa'in*): every empty space especially the space between the earth and the heavens. It also means “coward” {T}.

“الهِوَى” (*al-hawa*): human desire or wish.

“هَوِيَّ” (*hawiyah*), “يَهْوَاهُ” (*yahwahu*), “هَوَى” (*hawyan*): to like, or love.

“اسْتَهْوَى” (*istahwa*), “اسْتَهْوَاهُ” (*istihwa*): (6:71) he wanted to fell him, to bring him down, take away his intellect, or garnish his desire for him.

“هَوَى صَدْرُهُ يَهْوَى” (*hawa sadruhu yahwi*): his chest became bereft {T}.

Ibn Faris says that basically this root means “to be empty” and “to fall”.

The Quran says:

53:1	(the rising) star is witness to it when it is going down	وَالنَّجْمِ إِذَا هَوَىٰ
22:31	The wind may blow it away to a far off place.	أَوْ تَهْوِي بِهِ الرِّيحُ فِي مَكَانٍ سَحِينٍ
53:54	He vacated or dropped the destroyed dwellings	وَالْمُؤْتَفِكَةَ أَهْوَىٰ
14:43	Their hearts were being bereft of courage	وَأَفِيدَتْهُمْ هَوَاءٌ
14:37	And make it so, that people's hearts lean towards them	فَجَعَلَ أَفِيدَةً مِنَ النَّاسِ تَهْوِي إِلَيْهِمْ
2:87	You turned away and became rebellious if the messengers were not to your liking	لَا تَهْوَىٰ أَنْفُسُكُمْ--- إِنْ كُنْتُمْ

Human thoughts are called “هَوَى” (*hawa*) as compared to the “وَحَى” (*wahi*) in Surah *An-Najam*:

54:4	This Quran (whatever it says) is not comprised by the personal thoughts of the messenger instead it is the <i>wahi</i> (from God) which is sent to him	عَنِ الْهَوَىٰ إِنَّ هُوَ إِلَّا وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ
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Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:120	If you follow their personal thoughts after receiving the knowledge of <i>wahi</i> ...	وَلِّينَ التَّبَعْتَ أَهْوَاءَهُمْ بَعْدَ الَّذِي جَاءَكَ مِنَ الْعِلْمِ---
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This makes it obvious that the Quran is not against all human desires (3:13). It is against the desires and thoughts which are not kept in check according to the knowledge of the *wahi*:

6:120	Most of them are those who, because they do not have the guidance of the <i>wahi</i> , mislead people away from the right path.	وَأَنَّ كَثِيرًا يَضِلُّونَ بِأَهْوَاءِهِمْ بِغَيْرِ عِلْمٍ
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These are the emotions or feelings which make man climb down from the loftiness of human quality and bring it down to an animal level:

20:81	And whoever followed the wrong path and was deprived of our Blessings fell into the depths of ignominy	وَمَنْ يَخْلُلْ عَلَيْهِ غُضَبِي فَقَدْ هَوَىٰ
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The *wahi* aims to take man up to higher purpose and loftiness, but man instead diverts from this path and follows his own self-interests. As a consequence falls into disrespect and lowliness:

7:176	If he (man) had followed Our Will (or Our laws), then We would have taken him to loftiness, but he clung to his desires (e.g. economic interests)	وَلَوْ شِئْنَا لَرَفَعْنَاهُ بِهَا وَلَكِنَّهُ أَخْلَدَ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ وَاتَّبَعَ هَوَاهُ
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That is, he gave up the *wahi* and instead started following his own desires and interests.

This is the lowly life that has been called “هَوَايَا” (*haawiyah*) (101:9-10), i.e. a life in which one's intellect fails to show him the way and the man wanders around in difficulties and ignominies, i.e. “a lowly existence”. In the words of the Quran “نَارٌ حَامِيَةٌ” (*naarun haamiyah*) which means “raging fire” – an inner fire of unhappiness, discontent, frustration, negative thoughts, inner conflicts, hypocrisy, negative emotions, emptiness, self-gratification, absence of higher purpose of life, etc.

As such, if man lives according to the permanent values he can live a heavenly life, and if he becomes unbridled and rebellious (which is said as giving in to the devil) then it results in a hellish life.

It is important to understand that as per the Quran human emotions are not despicable, and it is wrong to think that by suppressing these one can attain some kind of “spiritualism”. The Quran simply says that when human desires and the guidance of the *wahi* are in conflict, then for the sake of higher ideals, these desires must be modified and brought in line with the permanent values or to be sacrificed if required. The emotions for a higher life are linked to the permanent values given by the *wahi*. To keep human desires within the bounds of the *wahi* is what leads to the human self-development.. When the two are not in conflict, then satisfying the human desires is not condemnable.

Hiya هـ ي

“هِيَ اِمْرَاةٌ” (*hiya imra’atun*): she is a woman.
 “هِيَ حَيَّةٌ” (*hiya hayyah*): a snake (21:20).

He-Y-A هـ ي ا

“هَيَّا الْأَمْرَ تَهَيَّئْهُ” (*hayya al-amra tahyi’ah*): he sorted the matter, readied it, or smoothed it {T}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:10	Make the right situation available for us	وَهَيَّئْ لَنَا مِنْ أَمْرِنَا رَشَدًا
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“الْهَيْئَةُ” (*al-hai’ah*): some thing’s condition or situation or form {M}.

Raghib says “الْهَيْئَةُ” (*al-hai’ah*) can also be felt, i.e its form *etc.* and it can be unseen too, i.e. the mental image or the feelings in the heart which are not before us palpably, but with insight we can glean them.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says that *Isa* said to the *Bani Israel*:

3:49	for you I will make a shape like the bird out of earth (Literal meaning)	إِنِّي أَخْلُقُ لَكُمْ مِنَ الطِّينِ كَهَيْئَةِ الطَّيْرِ
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Figuratively it means “I will give you a renaissance which will enable you to rise from the dust and fly into the heavens”, i.e. “you will attain the heights of knowledge, intellect, and conduct”. Here the *haiyat* (form) is not palpable, but is meant figuratively (which can be seen through an insight).

He-Y-T هـ ي ت

Faraa says that “هَيَّتْ لَكَ” (*haita laka*) is the title of the *Hurons* which somehow travelled to *Mecca* and the people there started using it. Some think that it has been derived from the Hebrew word *hailakh* which means “come here”, or “come quickly” {Lane}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to shout and “هَيَّيْتُ بِهِ” (*hayyat bih*) means “called out to him”.

Mujahid says it is a word which is said to instigate, i.e. “to buck up” {T}.

“هَيَّتْ” (*haita*) is also an exclamatory word.

“الْهَيْئَةُ” (*al-heet*): very low land {T}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says:

2:11	Present your evidence, bring it forth quickly	هَاتُوا بُرْهَانَكُمْ
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Khalil says that “هَاتُوا” (*haat*) actually is derived from “أَتَى يُوتَى” (*aata yuti*), and its “ا” (*alif*) has been replaced by “هـ” (*he*).

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:23	Come here	هَاتِ لَكَ
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- “الْبَيْحُ” (*al-haij*): to become mobile, to bring into motion.
 “بَاجَ الْإِبِلِ” (*haajal ibl*): he disturbed the camels at night (when they were at peace).
 “بَاجَ الْبَحْرِ” (*haajal bahr*): the sea became choppy and disturbed {M}.
 “بَاجَتِ الْإِبِلُ” (*haajatil ibl*): the camels became thirsty.
 “بَاجَ النَّبْتِ” (*haajan nabt*): the vegetables dried up {M}.
 “بَاجَ الْبَقْلِ” (*haajal baqal*): for a vegetable to be long and yellow and for it to dry up {T}.
 “الْبَاعِجَةُ” (*al-haa'ijah*): land where vegetables (grow on it) have become yellow and dried up {T}.

The Quran says about the crop:

39:21	then they dry up	ثُمَّ يَبْجُ
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Ibn Faris says this word basically means “to flare up” and “for plants to dry up”.

- “بَالَ عَلَيَّهِ التُّرَابُ” (*haala alaihit turaaba*), “بَيْلًا” (*hailan*), “بَيْلَهُ” (*haiyyelahu*) and “أَبَالَهُ” (*ahlahu*): he put mud over it, i.e. he buried it.
 “فَانْهَالَ” (*funhaala*), “تَهَيَّلَ” (*tahaiyyala*): so the soil was put on it, or fell from above.
 “رَمَلُ بَالٍ وَ أَبِيلٌ” (*ramlun haalin wa aheel*): sand in motion (blown by the wind).
 “الْهَيْلُ” (*al-hai-lu*) and “الْهَالُ” (*al-haal*): sand that falls down.
 “كَسْبُ الْهَيْلِ” (*kaseebun aheel*): sand dune whose sand falls down.
 “الْهَيْوُلُ” (*al-huyuul*): the specs which can be seen in the light that comes in through ventilators.
 “الْهَالَةُ” (*al-haalah*): the circle seen around the moon {T}.

Ibn Faris says that it means “to give without measuring a thing which can be measured”, that is, “to push something along, just like the way shifting sand shifts”.

The Quran says:

73:14	The time when the earth or the mounts will shake up and mountains will become like sand dunes which fall down (because they have become loose) on their own	يَوْمَ تَرْجُفُ الْأَرْضُ وَالْجِبَالُ وَكَانَتِ الْجِبَالُ كَثِيبًا مَهَيْلًا
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This is a very appropriate likeness of big wigs at the time of the Quranic revolution, that is, seemingly they will appear very powerful like the mountains, but their power would have ended like a crumbling sand dune at the banks of a river. This is indeed the condition of the wrong sort of culture. It cannot face the vicissitudes of time and the moment it is faced with the Quranic revolution, it falls down like a crumbling sand dune.

Ibn Faris says it means “extreme thirst”.

- “الْهَيْامُ” (*al-huyaam*): extreme thirst, a sickness due to which a camel becomes so thirsty that it is difficult to satiate it {T}.
 “الْأَهْيَمُ” (*al-ahyam*): the camel which is afflicted by the sickness of thirst and which cannot be satiated.
 “بَيْمَاءُ” (*haima'u*): the feminine camel as described above and “بَيْمٌ” (*heem*) is the plural form {T}.

The Quran says:

56:55	You will drink (fervently) like the camels who drink thirstily as if they are afflicted by the thirst sickness	فَشَارِبُونَ شُرْبَ الْهَيْمِ
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“رَجُلٌ يَبْمَانُ” (*rajulun hai-mun*): a thirsty man.
 “رَجُلٌ بَاعَمٌ” (*rajulun haayim*), “هَيُومٌ” (*huyum*): a surprised man.
 “هَامٌ فِي الْأَمْرِ يَهِيمُ” (*haama fil amri yaheem*): he was at a loss in the matter.
 “الْهَيَامُ” (*al-hiyaam*): the sand which if held in the hand does not stay but slips away gradually from the hand {T}.

Raghib says it means “dry sand”.

“الْهَيْمَاءُ” (*al-hai'ma*): a desolate desert that has no water {T}.
 “هَامَتِ النَّاقَةُ تَهِيمُ” (*haamatin naaqtu thayeem*): a she camel went around grazing at will in any direction.
 “لَيْلٌ أَلِيمٌ” (*lailun aheem*): a starless night, and therefore travellers are lost and cannot fix their direction.
 “الْهَيْمُ” (*al-heem*): lands which are porous or sandy, and absorb water {T}.

Let us view the above meanings and reflect on what the Quran has said about poetic mentality. The Quran has said that poetry is not befitting of a messenger (36:86). See heading (*Sh-Ain-R*). A messenger brings with him the revolutionary message of Allah, and he has a grand purpose before him. His every step leads towards this purpose from which he never dithers. He does not follow his own emotions, but traverses the straight path willingly and guided by the revelation. On the other hand, a poetic mentality is “فِي كُلِّ وَادٍ” (*fi kulli waadin yaheemun*), i.e. like a camel who is extremely thirsty and is wandering in extreme thirst in the desert of his own emotions (26:225). He wanders aimlessly and without direction because his thirst is unquenchable. All his life he wanders this way and his poetry produces no concrete results.

This is the difference between a Messenger and a poet. A poet wanders thirstily in a land of his emotions just like a camel in thirst whose thirst can never be quenched because he is suffering from a sickness. This journey is bleak because there are no landmark stars on the way. As against this, a Messenger calmly traverses on his way towards his fixed destination. Poetry is the following of emotions and messenger-hood is the following of truths. A *Muslim* was entrusted with the “messenger-hood”, i.e. not only to follow Allah’s laws oneself but take the message to others as well. But he gave this up and now wanders aimlessly and without direction, like a thirsty camel which wanders in a desolate place, but doesn’t find any place where he can quench his thirst. Thirst for him is like a sickness because the thirst is not real. How deplorable this depiction is. The irony is that this nation (of *muslims*) which has turned into a community of poets also has this book (the Quran) under its arm. It is like having the stream in front of one and still be in search of water for quenching the thirst. How could such a thirsty camel’s thirst be quenched?

He-Y-M-N

ه ي م ن

“هَيَّيْنَا الطَّائِرَ عَلَى فِرَاجِهِ” (*hai munit taa'iru ala firaakhihi*): the bird spread its wings over its young ones in order to protect them.

“هَيَّيْنَا عَلَى كَذَا” (*hai mana ala kaza*): he became his protector {T}.

Allah has called the Quran “مُهَيِّمٌ” (*mahai-mun*) of all previously revealed books (5:48). This means “the preserver of all truths noted in those previous books”. Even Allah is “الْمُهَيِّمُ” (*al-muhai'mun*) himself, i.e. He protects the universe like a mother bird protects its young ones.

Ibn Faris says that “الْمُهَيِّمُ” (*al-mhaimun*) is derived from “أَمْنٌ” (*amn*).

“الْهَيْهَاتَ” (*al-hai’hu*): one who is removed to one side because of his dirty clothes.
 “هَيْهَاتَ” (*hai’haat*) is a word which means “better if it is removed” {T}.

The Quran speaking in the words of the unbelievers of the life after death says:

23:36	How farfetched is the thing which you are being told will definitely occur	هَيْهَاتَ هَيْهَاتَ لِمَا تُوعَدُونَ
23:37	Our earthly life is what it is. We live, we die and do not get revived.	إِنْ هِيَ إِلَّا حَيَاتُنَا الدُّنْيَا نَمُوتُ وَنَحْيَا وَمَا نَحْنُ بِمَبْعُوثِينَ

In other words, they tell their friends “the messenger tells you that you will be raised to life after your death, how impossible is this to believe?”

1) “وَ” (**wa**): and.

32:37	Their four-legged (animals) and they themselves	أَنفُسُهُمْ وَ أَنعَا مُهُمْ
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2) “وَ” (**wa**): along with.

10:71	Consolidate your matter along with your partners	فَاجْمَعُوا أَمْرَكُمْ وَ شُرَكَاءَكُمْ
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3) “وَ” (**wa**): or.

3:111	Through Allah’s promise or through people’s promise	بِحَبْلِ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَ حَبْلِ مِنَ النَّاسِ
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4) “وَ” (**wa**): so that.

6:27	If only we were sent back (to the world) so that we could not be among the unbelievers	يَلَيِّنَا نُرْذِ وَ لَا تُكَذِّبَ
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5) “وَ” (**wa**): that is.

21:69	O fire, cool down on <i>Ibrahim</i> , that is , become peaceful	قُلْنَا يَا نَارُ كُونِي بَرْدًا وَسَلَامًا عَلَىٰ إِبْرَاهِيمَ
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According to the context, the translation of “وَ” (**wa**) here would be more appropriate as ‘that is’.

6) “وَ” (**wa**): to mean “a promise” or “swear”.

103:1	Swear upon the times (the time is witness to that....)	وَالْعَصْرِ
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7) “وَ” (**wa**) is sometimes additional.

37:103	So when they both bent over and he made his son lie down face down, then We called out	فَلَمَّا أَسْلَمَا وَتَلَّهُ لِلْجَبِينِ وَنَادَيْنَاهُ
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Here even without “وَ” (**wa**) the meaning of the phrase remains the same.

8) “وَ” (**wa**): although.

2:44	Although you follow the Book	وَ أَنْتُمْ تَتْلُونَ الْكِتَابَ
2:42	Although you well know	وَ أَنْتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ

Ibn Faris says the basic meaning of this root is heavy and harshness.

“الْوَادُ” (*al-waadu*) and “الْوَعْدُ” (*al-wa’eed*): loud and harsh voice, the mumbling of a camel.

“وَادٌ فُلَانًا” (*waada fulana*): it burdened that man {*T, M*}.

“وَعْدٌ” (*wa’eed*): the camels’ heavy tread due to carrying load.

“وَادَ الْبِنْتَ يَادُوْا أَدًا” (*a’adal binta ya’edan waada*): buried the girl alive in the ground, and buried her under tons of earth, burdened her with the load of the earth. During the dark period, the *Kunda* tribe of the Arabs used to bury their daughters alive.

A girl who was buried alive this way was called “الْمَوْدَةُ” (*al-mau’oodat*) and “الْوَيْدَةُ” (*al-wa’eedah*).

The Quran says:

81:8-9	When the girl buried alive will be asked as to why she was buried alive	وَ إِذَا الْمَوْءِدَةُ سُئِلَتْ بِأَيِّ ذَنْبٍ قُتِلَتْ
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The Messenger **Muhammed** used to make the women agree that they would not kill their daughters (60:12). It may be that the word “قَتَل” (*qatal*) here means “to keep them without education” out of fear of spending money on them with no result. See heading (*Q-T-L*) and (*Dh-B-H*).

This refers not only to the girls during the dark era but all the girls (even in today’s world) for all times who are “buried alive” i.e. who spend their entire lives as cattle, like they are neither dead nor alive. They are buried in a way in their houses from where they cannot be go out and use their potentials. Until the marriage and divorce is according to the Quranic system (and not that which we think is the way), girls and women will continue to suffer and their abilities will remain un-realised. The women in the west have now managed to get some rights in terms of education, training, etc.

W-A-L و ا ل

“وَأَلَّ إِلَيْهِ” (*wa’ala ilaih*), “يَبْتَغِي وَأَلَّ” (*ya’ilu waala*): sought refuge some place, went towards him with alacrity, turned towards him.
 “وَأَلَّ مِنْهُ” (*a’ala minhu*): to seek refuge.
 “أَلْوَالُ” (*al-waalu*), “أَلْوَالُ” (*al-mu’ilau*), “أَلْمَوَالُ” (*al-maw alah*): a place for deliverance and refuge, sanctuary.

Ibn Faris says it means “to congregate” and “to seek refuge”.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:58	Place of refuge	مَوَالٍ
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W-B-R و ب ر

“أَوْبَرُ” (*al-wabar*) with its plural form “أَوْبَارُ” (*au-baar*) means hair of the camel, goat or fox.
 “أَهْلُ الْوَبَرِ” (*ahlul wabar*): those who live in the desert.

The Quran uses the word “أَوْبَرُ” (*au-baar*) in (16:80). Also see heading (*Sd-W-F*).

W-B-Q و ب ق

“مَوْبِقًا” (*maubiq*) “وَبِقًا” (*wabaqa*), “وَبَقًا” (*yabaq*), “وَبَقَ” (*wabaq*), “وَبِقَ” (*wabaq*): to be annihilated.
 “أَلْمَوْبِقُ” (*al-maubiq*): a place where killing takes place, like an altar.
 “مَوْبِقٌ” (*maubiq*): an obstruction and barrier, a prison.
 “أَوْبَقَهُ” (*au-baqahu*): stopped him, imprisoned him, killed him {*T, M, R*}.
 “وَبِقَ” (*wabaq*): to be annihilated.

Ibn Faris says that “أَلْمَوْبِقُ” (*al-maubiq*) means “anything that acts as a barrier between two things”.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:52	Built a barrier between them (Made their relationship a means of their annihilation).	وَجَعَلْنَا بَيْنَهُمْ مَوْبِقًا
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Surah *Ash-Shura* says:

42:34	destroy them	أَوْ يُؤْبِقُهُنَّ
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As such “أَلْمَوْبِقَاتُ” (*al-mubiquat*) means “sins which lead to destruction” {*T, M, R*}.

“الْوَيْلُ” (*al-wabl*), “الْوَابِلُ” (*al-waabil*): heavy rain (2:264).
 “الْوَيْيلُ” (*al-wabeel*): intense {T}.

73:16	So We seized him in a ruinous seizure	فَأَخَذْنَا نَاهُ أَخْذًا وَبِيلًا
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“ضَرْبٌ وَبِيلٌ” (*zarbun wabeel*): hard strike.
 “وَبِيلٌ” (*wabeelun*): the staff of the washer man with which he beats the clothes {T}.
 “الْوَبَالُ” (*al-wabaal*): intensity, harshness, dislike, chaos, misery, disagreeable, unsuitable {T}.
 “وَبَالٌ أَمْرُهُ” (*wabaala amrihi*): the bad results of one’s deeds (5:95).

Ibn Faris says its basic meanings include the element of intensity.

This root also means “to congregate”.

“الْوَتْدُ” (*al-watad*): peg. The plural is “أَوْتَادٌ” (*autaad*).
 “وَتْدٌ” (*watada*), “الْوَتْدُ” (*al-watida*), “يَتْدُهُ” (*yatidahu*), “وَتْدًا” (*watda*): he drove a peg into the ground or wall.
 “الْمِيتْدُ” (*al-meetad*): the hammer with which the peg is driven.
 “الْوَاتِدُ” (*al-waatid*): a profound or established (pegged) thing.
 “وَتْدُ فُلَانٌ رِجْلُهُ فِي الْأَرْضِ” (*wattada fulanun rijlahu fil ard*): they established themselves there.
 “أَوْتَادُ الْأَرْضِ” (*autaadul ard*): mountains.
 “أَوْتَادٌ مِنَ الْبِلَادِ” (*autaadun minal bilaad*): the elite of the city {T, R}.

The Quran has called the pharaoh as “ذُو الْأَوْتَادِ” (*zul autaad*) in (38:12), which means “having very powerful forces”. It is also used for someone whose pegs are driven far and wide. Mountains have also been called “أَوْتَادًا” (*autaada*) in (78:7) because they are pegged into the ground.

The terms of “إبدال” (*abdal*) and “أوتاد” (*autaad*) which exist in the language of the Sufism, are not Quranic.

“الْوَتْرُ” (*al-watr*), “الْوَتْرُ” (*al-witr*): individual or individual thing, as against “شَفْعٌ” (*shaf'a*) {T, R}.

The Quran says:

89:3	Odd figure as against even	وَالشَّفْعُ وَالْوَتْرُ
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“وَتْرَهُ مَالَهُ وَحَقَّهُ” (*watarahu maalahu wa haqahu*): he reduced his wealth and right.

The Quran says:

47:35	He will not reduce anything which you have earned with your deeds	وَلَنْ يَرُدَّكُمْ عَنْ أَعْمَالِكُمْ
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“وَتْرٌ” (*watara*): to avenge and commit excesses. It also means to separate a pair {T, R}.
 “الْوَتْرُ” (*al-witr*): enmity due to killing {M}.
 “تَتْرَى” (*tatra*) which actually was “وَتْرَى” (*watara*) but was later changed, mena “for things to appear so that there is a gap between them”. If such objects continue to come without gaps, they will not be called

“مُتَوَاتِرٌ” (*mutawatir*) or “continuous” but “مُتَتَابِعٌ” (*muta’taabih*) or “مُتَدَارِكٌ” (*muta’daarik*) or “مُتَوَاصِلٌ” (*mutawasil*).

“جَاءَتِ الْخَيْلُ تُتْرَىٰ” (*ja’atil khilu tatra*): the horses came one after the other with gaps in between.

“مُؤَاتَرَةُ الصَّوْمِ” (*muwataratus saum*): to fast one day and abstain for a couple of days from fasting.

“مُؤَاتَرَةٌ” (*muwatarah*) must have a gap in between. If there is no gap then it will be called “مُدَارَكَةٌ” (*mudaarakatun*) or “مُؤَاصَلَةٌ” (*muwasalah*) {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

23:44	then We kept sending Our messengers from time to time continuously	ثُمَّ أَرْسَلْنَا رُسُلَنَا تَتْرًا
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“الْوَيْتَرَةُ” (*al-wateerah*): to hesitate in some work.

Ibn Faris says the many words from this root are very dissimilar and have their own separate meanings (i.e. these are not related to the root).

W-T-N و ت ن

“الْوَاتِنُ” (*al-waatin*): a thing which is always stolid in its place.

“الْمَاءُ الْوَائِنُ” (*al-maa’ul waatin*): water that flows forever and does not stop.

“الْوَاتِينُ” (*al-wateen*): the vital chord which makes a man die if cut {*T*}.

The Quran says:

69:46	then We cut his vital chord	ثُمَّ لَقَطَعْنَا مِنْهُ الْوَتِينَ
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W-Th-Q و ث ق

“وَتَاقٌ” (*wisaaq*), “وَتَاقٌ” (*wasaaq*): is the rope etc. with which something is fettered. Some say “وَتَاقٌ” (*wasaaq*) means to tie and “وَتَاقٌ” (*wisaaq*) is the fetter itself.

“وَتَقَهُ” (*ausaqah*): tied it firmly with a rope {*T*}.

“وَتَقَ الشَّيْءُ” (*wasaaq-ashay*): that thing became firm and tight.

The Quran says:

89:26	the thing became entrenched and established	وَلَا يُؤْتِي وَتَاقَهُ أَحَدٌ
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The Quran says “الْعُرْوَةُ الْوُثْقَىٰ” (*al-urwatul-wusqaa*) which has been explained by saying “لَا انْفِصَامَ لَهَا” (*la an fisaama laha*) in (2:256) i.e. “which does not break”.

“مَيْتَاقٌ” (*maisaaq*) and “مَوْثِقٌ” (*mausiq*): firm promise, solid commitment.

“وَيْقَ بِهِ” (*wasiq bihi*): to trust someone, to think him to be trust worthy {*T*}.

“إِسْتَوْثِقَ مِنْهُ” (*istawsiq inhu*): obtained a trust worthy pledge from him {*T*}.

“كَبَلًا مَوْثِقًا” (*kala’un musaq*): enough fodder to make one believe that it will be enough for one year.

Raghib says “الْمَيْتَاقُ” (*al-meesaq*) means an agreement which is linked with swearing or promises {*R*}.

“وَتَنَ بِالْمَكَانِ” (*wasana bil makaan*): he stayed somewhere, became a resident somewhere.
 “الْوَائِنِ” (*al-waasin*): established and stolid and resident which does not move from its place.
 “وَتَنُ بُتْ” (*wasanan but*): a statue which cannot move from its place {*T, R*}. The plural is “أَوْتَانُ” (*ausaan*) as in 29:17.

Taj and *Kitaabal Ashqaaq* say that “وَتَنُ” (*wasan*) means “a small statue”. As per this meaning, every system that is static and does not progress is “وَتَنُ” (*wasan*), i.e. “a small idol of sorts”, which every dead nation worships.

The Quran is a code of life revealed for the entire mankind for all times and whenever it is given a practical shape (i.e. it is fully acted upon), then it creates an extremely dynamic society. Staying within the parameters of the permanent values of the Quran, a society stays with the times and moves ahead. Thus this system attains the shape of a dynamic movement and if it stops and becomes static at some point, then it turns into idol worship. This takes place among nations which suffer from mental and practical inertia. We consider that stone statues are not worth worshipping, but do not mind the hidden idols in the form of false beliefs in our hearts and minds!

“وَجَبَّ الْبَعِيرُ تَوَجَّيًّا” (*wajjabal ba'eeru taujeeba*): the camel sat on the ground and sat staunchly {*T, R*}.
 “الْمَوْجِبُ” (*al-muwajjib*): the camel which due to plumpness cannot get up.
 “وَجَبَّ الْحَائِطُ” (*wajjabal haa*): the wall fell down.
 “وَجَبَّ الرَّجُلُ وَجُوبًا” (*wajabar rajulu wujuba*): the man died, i.e. fell down so that he never got up.
 “الْوَجْبَةُ” (*al-wajabah*): for something to fall down with a sound.
 “الْمَوْجِبُ” (*al-maujib*): death {*T, R*}.

About the camels which are slaughtered, the Quran says:

22:36	when they fall on their sides (when they become cold (due to death))	فَإِذَا وَجَبَتْ جُنُوبُهَا
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Ibn Faris says it basically means to fall down, or some event to take place.

“وَجَبَّ الشَّيْءُ” (*wajabash shaiyi*): for something to become firm or become necessary and obligatory.
 “أَوْجَبَهُ” (*au jabahu*), “وَجَبَهُ” (*aj-jabahu*): he established it and made it firm.
 “اسْتَوْجَبَهُ” (*istaujabahu*): he became deserving of it {*T*}, he thought it mandatory {*T*}.
 “وَأَجَبَ لِفُلَانٍ حَقَّهُ” (*waajabal li fulanin haqqahu*): he conceded his right {*T*}.

“وَجَدَ” (*wajada*), “وَجُودًا” (*wujuda*): to acquire something. It is also sometimes used to mean to know something, and gain knowledge about it, but it is also used with certain changes to mean other things.
 “مَوْجِدَةً” (*maujidatan*), “وَجْدَانًا” (*wajidaana*): anger.
 “وَجَدَ عَلَيْهِ” (*wajada alaih*): he was angry at him.
 “وَجَدَ يَجِدُ” (*wajada yajid*): to be wealthy and care free.
 “الْوَجْدُ” (*al-wijd*), “الْوَجْدُ” (*al-wajd*), “الْوَجْدُ” (*al-wujd*): wealthiness, vastness and expansion.
 “وَجَدَنِي” (*wajada bihi*), “وَجَدَا” (*wajda*): loved him or her.
 “إِنَّهُ لَيَجِدُ بِفُلَانَةٍ وَجْدًا شَدِيدًا” (*innahu layajidu bifulanah wajdan shadeeda*): he loves that woman and becomes sad in her absence.
 “وَجَدَنِي” (*wajada bihi*): he loved her and was sad.
 “الْوَجِيدُ” (*al-wajeed*): level ground {*T, M*}.

“الْوَّاجِدُ” (*al-waajid*): rich, strong, wealthy {*T, M*}.
 “وُجْدٌ” (*wujd*): capacity, power (65:6).

The Quran says:

2:96	You will find them to be most greedy	وَلَتَجِدَنَّهُمْ أَخْرَصَ النَّاسِ
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This word has been used mostly in this meaning.

“وُجُودٌ” (*wujudun*) or “مَوْجُودٌ” (*maujuud*) are words which are not found in the Quran. These are the terms coined by the linguists.

W-J-S

و ج س

“الْوَّجْسُ” (*al-wajs*): secret voice or the voice of your heart.
 “الْوَّاجِسُ” (*al-wajis*): the thought that crosses your heart (mind).
 “الْإِيجَاسُ” (*al-eejaas*): to feel something in the heart and to keep it concealed. A passing thought in which there is no element of fear {*T*}.

The Quran says about *Ibrahim*:

11:70	he felt a little fear of them in his heart	وَأَوْجَسَ مِنْهُمْ خِيفَةً
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W-J-F

و ج ف

“وَجَفَ الشَّيْءُ” (*wajafash shaiyu*): for something to be disturbed.
 “قَلْبٌ وَاجِفٌ” (*qalbun waajif*): a troubled heart (that beats fast) {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

79:8	That day, hearts will be troubled and worried	قُلُوبٌ يَوْمَئِذٍ وَاجِفَةٌ
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“وَجَفَ الْفَرَسُ” (*wajafal fars*): for a horse to run fast.
 “أَوْجَفْتُهُ” (*au jafutuhu*): I made it run fast.

The Quran says:

59:6	So you have not raced horses and camels there.	فَمَا أَوْجَفْتُمْ عَلَيْهِ مِنْ خَيْلٍ وَلَا رِكَابٍ
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W-J-L

و ج ل

“الْوَجَلُ” (*al-wajal*): fear and worry.
 “وَجَلَ” (*wajil*), “يُوجَلُ” (*yaujal*): to worry, to fear, one who fears and worries is called “وَجِيلٌ” (*wajil*). The plural is “وَجِيلُونَ” (*wajiloon*) as in (15:52).
 “الْوَجِيلُ” (*al-wajeel*), “الْمَوْجِلُ” (*al-maujil*): a ditch in which water accumulates.
 “الْوُجُلُ” (*al-wujul*): old folk {*T*}.

Raghib says that “الْوَجَلُ” (*al-wajal*) means to fret in one’s heart or fret secretly {*R*}.

The Quran says that one of the characteristics of the *momineen* is:

8:2	When God is mentioned, they get a feeling of fear (lest they are not doing what He wants)	إِذَا ذُكِرَ اللَّهُ وَجِلَتْ قُلُوبُهُمْ
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As mentioned at other places “fear of God” is “to fear the destructive results that wrong deeds bring”, or “to fear the destructive results if the guidance is not followed”.

Ibn Faris says it basically means for something to appear.

“وَجَاهُ الشَّيْءِ” (*wajhush shaiyi*): against something or to be face to face {M}.

“الْوَجْهَ” (*al-wajhu*): the part of anything that is seen first.

“الْوَجْهَ” (*al-wajhu*) is part of the human body which appears first of all.

Since man's face appears first, it is called “وَجْهَ” (*wajhu*) {M, T, Lataif-ul-Lugha}. But later this word came to mean personality {M, T, Lataif-ul-Lugha}.

Verse (2:112) says “مَنْ أَسْلَمَ وَجْهَهُ لِلَّهِ” (*mun aslama wajhahu lillaah*). Here “وَجْهَ” (*wajhun*) means the entire person not just the face.

Surah **Bani Israel** says:

17:7	Lest they make your condition very bad (they turn the condition of your leaders as very bad)	لِيَسْؤُوا وَجْهَكُمْ
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“وَجْهَ الْقَوْمِ” (*wajhul qaum*): the head of the nation or very respected person of a nation.

“وَجْهَ النَّهَارِ” (*wajhun nahaar*): the initial part of the day.

“الْوَجْهَ مِنَ الدَّيْرِ” (*al-wajhu minad dahr*): the early part of the era, i.e. part of the times (era) which appears initially.

“الْوَجْهَ” (*al-wajhu*): rank, respect too.

“الْوَجْهَ” (*al-wajih*): man with respect or rank.

“الْوَجْهَ” (*al-wajihah*): a cloth which is similar on both sides.

About **Moosa** it has been said:

33:69	a respectful man	وَكَانَ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ وَجِيهًا
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“وَجْهَ” (*wajhun*): purpose, object, the way which is adopted to reach the destination, course, direction, the destination towards which one is moving.

“وَجْهَ الطَّرِيقِ” (*wajhut tareeq*): the path which leads to the destination {L}.

“وَجْهَ الْأَمْرِ” (*wajhul amr*): the purpose of something and the right way.

“جِهَتُهُ” (*jihatun*) and “وَجْهَتُهُ” (*wijhatun*) also means as above, or purpose, reason, raison d'être.

“مَتَوَجِّهٌ” (*mutawajjah*): the place towards which one is going.

The Quran says about the deeds:

2:272	Seeking the purpose ordained by Allah	إِتِّعَاءَ وَجْهِ اللَّهِ
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Generally it is translated to mean for Allah's pleasure or to make him agreeable. This turns one's minds towards the emotions of displeasure or pleasure. God is above such emotions.

“وَجْهَ اللَّهِ” (*wajhil laah*): the purpose which Allah has ordained, the destination towards which the laws of Allah take us, i.e. every deed must be for the purpose as ordained by Allah, every deed of man should be for reaching the destination that Allah's law has ordained or fixed for it.

Surah **Ar-Room** says:

30:39	Whatever you give for the development of mankind is meant to take you to your intended objective	وَمَا آتَيْتُمْ مِنْ زَكَاةٍ تُرِيدُونَ وَجْهَ اللَّهِ
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This makes the meaning of the verse clear in which it is said:

28:88	Whatever man does undergoes change	كُلُّ شَيْءٍ هَالِكٌ إِلَّا وَجْهَهُ
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This is what “بَلَك” (*haalaka*) means, but permanence is enjoyed only by the deeds which are made to reach the destination which Allah’s laws have destined, or that every worldly way undergoes change excepting the way that takes one to the destination fixed by Allah {*M*}.

This is also meant by these verses of Surah *Ar-Rahman*:

55:25	Every path is subject to change excepting the one which takes one to the great development	كُلُّ مَنْ عَلَيْهَا فَانٍ وَيَبْقَى وَجْهُ رَبِّكَ ذُو الْجَلَالِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ
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This has been called:

92:20	Every nation in the world has its own objective in life and every individual too	إِيتِئَاءَ وَجْهِ رَبِّهِ الْأَعْلَى
2:148	The group of <i>momineen</i> is such that wherever in the world it may be, and in whichever sphere, its purpose in life focuses on the destination fixed by the laws of God	وَلِكُلٍّ وَجْهَةٌ هُوَ مُوَلِّئُهَا
2:115	So wherever you turn, you find yourself according to Allah’s intend. (His laws are operational everywhere)	فَإِنَّمَا تُنَوِّلُوا فِئَمَّ وَجْهَ اللَّهِ

W-H-D و ح د

“الْوَحْدُ” (*al-waahid*): the number “one”.

“وَاحِدٌ” (*waahid*) and “أَحَدٌ” (*ahad*) both mean “one” but there is a difference in their usage. When it is said “مَا أَتَانِي مِنْهُمْ أَحَدٌ” (*ma atani minhum ahad*), it will mean “nobody from among them came to me”. But when it is said “جَاءَ نَبِيٌّ مِنْهُمْ وَاحِدٌ” (*ja’a nabi minhim waahid*), then it would mean that “only one person came to me (not two)” {*T*}.

Ibn Faris has said that “هُوَ وَاحِدٌ قَبِيلَاتِيهِ” (*huwa wahidihu qabililatih*) means “he is outstanding among his tribe”.

Raghib prefers the meaning given above.

The Quran has used the term “وَاحِدٌ” (*waahid*) to mean Allah too (12:39) as well as “أَحَدٌ” (*ahad*) as in (112:1).

Muheet says that He who is alone in His personality is “أَحَدٌ” (*ahad*) as well as “وَاحِدٌ” (*waahid*), and nobody shares His traits or qualities. As such “أَحَدٌ” (*ahad*) would mean without parallel, unique. The basic characteristic of a personality is, i.e. it is “unique”.

“قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ” (*qul huwal laahu ahad*) relates this uniqueness of Allah’s personality (112:1).

“الْأَحْدَانُ” (*al-uhdaanu*): arrows which are unique and unparalleled {*T*}.

“الْمِيعَادُ” (*al-meehaad*): a dune which stands alone and away from other dunes {*M*}.

“إِتَّحَدَ الشَّيْءَانُ” (*it-tahadash shaiyaan*): both things intermingled. Figuratively this word means “to agree”.

All Quranic teachings are based on the “Oneness of God”, that is, upon the fact there is only one power (Sovereign) which enjoys total domination and power. There is no other law or power except His. As such, in the world of humans too, His law must operate.

18:110	(Therefore <i>momin</i> is he) who does not include anyone else in the Laws of his Sustainer.	لَا يُشْرِكْ بِعِبَادَةِ رَبِّهِ أَحَدًا
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That is, a *momin* is someone who does not bow his head before anyone’s law but His (which He has revealed in the Quran). Also see heading (*A-H-D*).

“الْوَحْشُ” (*al-wahsh*): wild animal. The plural is “وُحُوشٌ” (*wuhush*). Singular is “وَحْشِيٌّ” (*wahshi*).

“وَحْشِيٌّ” (*wahshi*): inhabited and desolate place {*R*}.

“مَكَانٌ وَحْشٌ” (*makaanun wahsh*): vacant place.

“بَلَدٌ وَحْشٌ” (*baladun wahsh*): an area which is desolate and uninhabited.

“بَاتَ وَحْشًا” (*baata wahsha*): he spent the night hungry (he was with empty stomach) {*T*}.

“الْوَحْشُ” (*al-wahsh*): the opposite of “الْأَنْسُ” (*al-ins*) {*R*}, that is “not familiar”, “wild”.

“ذَالِكَ مِنْ وَحْشِ النَّاسِ” (*zaalika min wahshin naas*): this man is from among the lowly people and those who hate humans {*M*}.

The Quran says:

81:5	And when the “unfamiliar” are gathered	وَإِذَا الْوُحُوشُ حُشِرَتْ
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Here the word can mean “unfamiliar” as well as “wild animals” and “wild and uncouth people”.

“الْوَحْيُ” (*al-wahyu*): quick indication.

“وَحَيْتُ لَكَ بِخَبَرٍ كَذَا” (*wa haitu lak bi khabari kaza*): I signalled you about that thing, informed you quietly {*T, R*}.

Surah *Maryam* says that *Zakariya* was told not to speak to people:

19:11	As such he signalled the people (used sign language)	فَأَوْحَى إِلَيْهِمْ
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Raghib says and *Taj* supports him in this, that “الْوَحْيُ” (*al-wahi*) means a quick signal.

“شَيْءٌ وَحِيٌّ” (*shaiyun wahi-un*): the thing that comes quickly.

“أَمْرٌ وَحِيٌّ” (*amrun wahiyyun*): quick matter.

“الْوَحْيُ” (*al-waha*): to be speedy.

“أَوْحَى الْعَمَلُ” (*auhal amal*): he was fast in work.

“الْوَحْيُ” (*al-wahi*): to write.

“وَحَيْتُ الْكِتَابَ” (*wa hait-ul-kitaab*): I wrote that book.

“وَاحٍ” (*waahin*): someone who writes.

“الْوَحْيُ” (*al-wahyu*): that which is written.

“أَوْحَى” (*au-ha*): to order.

Johri says that “الْوَحْيُ” (*al-wahyu*) means “الْكِتَابُ” (*al-kitaab*), i.e. the Quran itself. *Lataif-ul-Lugha, Ibn Faris* and *Raghib* support this.

Surah *Al-Ma'idah* says:

5:111	Revelation sent to the companions	وَإِذْ أَوْحَيْتُ إِلَى الْحَوَارِيِّينَ
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Hence here it means the written order that was given through the Revelation which, according to *Raghib*, was sent through *Isa* in written form.

Taj says in the afore-mentioned verse that to *wahi* towards the fellowship of *Isa* means that “God had ordered them” {*T, R*}, and this *wahi* was relayed to the fellowship through *Isa* (Jesus) {*R*}.

Ibn Faris says that anything which you impart to others, and they become aware of it is called “وَحْيٌ” (*wahi*), regardless of the condition you impart it in, may be secretly or otherwise.

Surah *As-Sajdah* says:

41:12	he imparted the <i>wahi</i> in all the heavens	وَأَوْحَى فِي كُلِّ سَمَاءٍ أَمْرَهَا
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To **amr** the **wahi** means “to appoint the laws made by God according to which everything in the universe carries on.

This has been related in Surah **An-Noor** as:

24:41	everything in the universe knows what its obligations are and it must do what has been ordained for it	كُلٌّ قَدْ عَلِمَ صَلَاتَهُ وَتَسْبِيحَهُ
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This is the **wahi** which is operative in all the things, i.e. the **amr** or “the will of Allah”, or “Allah’s law”.

About this, Surah **Az-Zalzaal** says:

99:5	for this purpose, God has made wahi towards the earth (ordered the earth about it)	بِأَنَّ رَبَّكَ أَوْحَىٰ لَهَا
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Hence it is the law about the earth from God.

Surah **An-Nahal** says:

16:68	God has made the wahi towards the honey bee (God’s law ordains that it should operate in such a way)	وَ أَوْحَىٰ رَبُّكَ إِلَى النَّحْلِ
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Everything in the universe is operating according to Allah’s **wahi** (order). This **wahi** has been ingrained in everything. This is called “law of nature” or for living things it is called “instinct”. This law or order is not created by those things themselves but has been created by God.

Man is a part of the universe and therefore for it too it is necessary that it must live or exist as per some law which has not been created by him but is given by some external source. As far as his corporeal self is concerned, it is guided by the same principles that apply to other animals, i.e. to eat, sleep, wake up, reproduction, sickness, death; all are similar and follow the same law. These laws are not self-made.

Humans have a social and civilized life too, aside from their physical life. They also have a Self consisting of their strong sense of identity, meta cognition, emotions and memory. For this man needs a law as well and that law must also not be self-made but given to it by some external source. This law too is called **wahi**, but difference is that everyone does not get this **wahi** individually. God willed that this **wahi** be given to a man who would relay it to others and that man used to be called a “messenger”. This **wahi** was particular to such messengers.

Nothing in the universe has the right to accept or reject the law which has been ordained for it, but man has been given the right whether he wants to live according to this **wahi** or not. This is because for the development of his personality, it is necessary that he exercises his right to choose how he wants to live. The reason behind no man getting the **wahi** individually but through the messenger is also to let man choose his own way, because the things of the universe which get the **wahi** directly and individually are not allowed to deviate from the **wahi**. They have to follow the **wahi** at all costs as it is inbuilt and other than man, none else has the freedom to choose.

Man has been given the right to choose which way he wants to live, but he has not been given the right to change the results of the deeds that he chooses to do, i.e. good deeds will get good results and bad deeds will inevitably get bad results in terms of their consequences, and nobody can change this. Man can easily take poison or throw it away, but he does not have the right to make the poison produce the result as a piece of harmless sweet would. Indeed the purpose of the creation of humans with a free will is to hold them accountable for what they do (45:22).

The messengers did not get this **wahi** due to their own efforts but got selected by Allah. No man can reach up to the **wahi** but the **wahi** comes from its place and reaches man, i.e. it is revealed by God. In other words, it is not a subjective thing but objective. Man through his efforts can indeed discover the secrets of the things in the universe, but the truths that he gets through the **wahi** are acquired only through the messengers. This means that through the **wahi**, truth manifests itself upon the messenger (and through him to mankind, a messenger cannot himself unveil the truth). This is called the revelation of the **wahi**.

2:97	<i>Jibrail</i> has revealed it unto your heart	فَإِنَّهُ نَزَّلَهُ عَلَى قَلْبِكَ
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Since **wahi** was revealed only to the messengers as far as this world is concerned, we can never understand in what circumstances or how it was revealed. We can only develop our belief through the use of our intellect and reasoning and rational thinking it is from Allah and passed on to us by the messenger (although we are able to see some of the evidence presented). Also through the results of the orders of the **wahi**, we can judge the pragmatic truths in the **wahi**. The messengers sometimes got this **wahi** secretly and sometimes openly, but we can only get the **wahi** through the messenger's teachings.

This fact has been related by the Quran in Surah *Ash-Shura*:

42:51	And it is not upto any human that Allah should speak to him, except that he received wahi , or is spoken from behind a veil, or that messenger has been sent to him who reveals the wahi , according to the plans of Allah	وَمَا كَانَ لِنَشْرِ أَنْ يُكَلِّمَهُ اللَّهُ إِلَّا وَحْيًا أَوْ مِنْ وَرَائِهِ حِجَابٍ أَوْ يُرْسِلَ رَسُولًا فَيُوحِيَ بِإِذْنِهِ مَا يَشَاءُ
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In this it has been related how Allah “speaks” to man. Man is of two kinds, the messengers and other than the messengers (the common men). The first kind, i.e. the messengers, receive the message or **wahi** through the medium selected by Allah, like it has been said about the Messenger **Muhaammed**. Or it gets received by a voice which is directly heard, like from behind a curtain (as in the case of Moses). As for the second category of humans, they only receive the **wahi** through the messengers. Now this message is within the Quran, not anywhere outside it. In a way this Quran has also been revealed unto us (3:71, 2:105). That is, it has been revealed to us through the Messenger **Muhammed**. Since after the Messenger's death, **wahi** has been discontinued, and no man can now receive it directly – this is because the Quran is a complete book of guidance which deals with the human thought process.

Now only two fountainheads of knowledge are remaining for man. One is the **wahi** of Allah as contained in the **Quran**, and the second is man's own intellect. No man can get any knowledge aside from these two sources. Meditation and other such ideas find no credence with the Quran. See heading (**L-H-M**). If the Quran and man's intellect get together, they complete the human knowledge. The concept that the Messenger **Muhammed** received two kinds of **wahi**, one which is in the Quran and one which is out of it or in traditions only is a non-Quranic concept.

There is no mention of such a division of the **wahi** in the Quran (6:19). This was a concept which prevailed among the Jews and adopted by the **Muslims**. During the time of the Messenger there is no mention of **wahi-matlu** and **ghair-matlu** anywhere. At this point only these details about the **wahi** will be discussed. If more details are needed they can be seen in the book titled **Iblees and Adam** which discusses these things in greater detail.

“أَوْحَى إِلَيْهِ” (**auha ilaih**): to send as messengers.

“أَوْحَى الرَّجُلُ” (**auhar rajul**): he sent his trusted messenger to his trusted servant as an envoy {T}.

Ibnul Anbari says that **wahi** is called so because the angel brings it secretly to the person towards whom it is sent.

“إِيحَاءُ” (**eeha**) actually means to “talk secretly” with someone.

Abu Ishaq says that **wahi** actually means “إِعْلَامٌ فِي خَفَاءٍ” (**i'laam fi khafa-in**). That is why the Quran says it is something to put in the heart.

“أَوْحَتْ نَفْسُهُ” (**auhat nafsuhu**): there was fear in his heart, he fretted in his heart, and his heart developed a fear.

About **Isa's** mother, the Quran says:

20:38	We inspired Moosa's mother's heart to feed the baby, and let the baby flow in the river in a box if she developed any fear	أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَى أُمِّ مُوسَى
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As mentioned earlier, “وَحْيٌ” (*wahyun*) is anything that is sent toward anybody so that he or she becomes aware of it, or to send knowledge towards somebody no matter how it is done. Thus to send *wahi* towards *Isa’s hawaris* or fellowship of *Isa* means to send order towards them (through *Isa*). In the same way, to send *wahi* towards the mother of *Moosa* would mean to send an order or news through somebody to her.

Wahi to messengers was particular only to them. To believe from the word “أَوْحَيْنَا” (*awhaina*) that a common human being could also receive the *wahi* like the messengers, is to go against the teachings of the Quran.

Note here that that which is called *wahi* to messengers, was received for the last time by the Messenger *Muhammed*, and is now safe in the Quran. After this no human being received nor will receive any other guidance directly from God as it has been completed. Anyone who claims to have done so, is either deceiving himself or is trying to deceive others.

Since *wahi* does not include any human wish or thought, the Quran has called it “الْعِلْمُ” (*al-ilm*) which is totally free of human thought (2:120) i.e. human beings do not think like the Quran and this is why no human being can produce verses like the Quran (2:23-24). At another place it has been said that there is no thought of the messenger himself in the *wahi* (i.e., it is entirely from God):

53:35	He does not say anything on his own but this is the <i>wahi</i> which has been sent towards him:	وَمَا يَنْطَلِقُ عَنِ الْهَوَىٰ - إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا وَحْيٌ يُوحَىٰ - عَلَّمَهُ شَدِيدُ الْقُوَىٰ
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He has been given this knowledge by the Great One (God). As has been said earlier, nobody except a messenger can receive this knowledge directly. Therefore the Messenger announces:

7:62	I know that (with the help of God) which you do not know	أَعْلَمُ مِنَ اللَّهِ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ
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Therefore the truths that are revealed through the *wahi* are not discoverable by human intellect. The human intellect needs the light of the *wahi* like the eye needs the sunlight. The path which has been defined by the *wahi* is the dependable guidance and will always lead to the truth and to the direction of the self-development. Note that the words of the *wahi* too are not the messengers’ but God’s.

“الْوَحْيُ” (*al-wahi*) also means the same as “الطَّرِيقُ الْمُعْتَمَدُ” (*at-tareeq ul-mu’tamad*), that is “dependable path” {*Lataif-al-Lagha*}.

W-D-D و د د

“الْوُدُّ” (*al-wudd*), “الْوَدَادُ” (*al-wadaad*): friendship, love.

Raghib says it means “to love something” and “to wish to belong to something”.

“الْمَوَدَّةُ” (*al-mawaddah*): love.

“الْوَدُ” (*al-wudd*): peg, although some think that it is a form of “الْوَتْدُ” (*al-watad*) whose root is (*W-T-D*) {*T*}.

The Quran says:

2:96	Every one of them so wishes	يَوَدُّ أَحَدُهُمْ
19:96	Allah the Kind, will create love (or good feeling) for them	سَيَجْعَلُ لَهُمُ الرَّحْمَنُ وُدًّا
85:14	Allah is very kind (who is very ‘loving’).	الْوُدُّودُ

Surah *Ar-Room* says about connubial relationship:

30:21	created mutual love between you (made you join each other so that you became supportive of each other)	جَعَلَ بَيْنَكُمْ مَوَدَّةً
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This verse points to the marital issues i.e. this is something which we need to use as a criterion to live happily within the contract of a marriage. If affection is missing then this needs to be worked at to create it through the study of the Quran.

Surah *Al-Mumtahuna* has used “مَوَدَّةً” (*mawaddah*) against enmity (60:7).

Surah *Ash-Shura* says:

42:23	Tell them “I demand no compensation for it (i.e. for communicating this guidance)” (I just want relationship to be maintained)	قُلْ لَا أَسْأَلُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ أَجْرًا إِلَّا الْمَوَدَّةَ فِي الْقُرْبَىٰ
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For its right meaning, see heading (*Q-R-B*).

Wadd

وَدَّ

“وَدَّ” (*wadd*), “سَوَاعُ” (*suwa-u*), “يَغُوْتُ” (*yaghus*), “يَعُوْقُ” (*ya-ooq*) and “نَسْرُ” (*nasr*) were idols that got worshiped during the period of *Noah* (71:23). The Arabs were well aware of these names. The idol named “وَدَّ” (*wudd*) was worshipped by the tribe of *Banu Kalb*.

W-D-Ain

وَدَعَ

“وَدَعَ” (*wada'a*), “يَدَعُ” (*yada'u*): something stopped, became static.

“وَدَعَ” (*wada'a*), “وَدَّعَ” (*wawadda*): left, gave up.

Ibn Faris says that this root basically means “to give up” and “to empty”.

“تَوَدَّعَ الْفَرِيقَانِ” (*tawada'al fareeqaan*): both opponents ceased fire.

“وَدَّيْعٌ” (*wadeeh*): ceasefire agreement. Later this word came to mean any type of agreement.

“الْوَدَّيْعُ” (*al-wadee'ah*): something which is kept in trust.

“الْوَدَّيْعَةُ” (*taudi'us saub*): to keep cloth in a safe place so that it is free of dust etc.

“تَوَدَّيْعُ الثَّوْبِ” (*tawadda-hu*): kept it in a safe place {T}.

“الْوَدَّيْعُ” (*al-wadeeh*): a quiet and stolid man.

“الْوَدَّعُ” (*al-wad'u*): a tomb where the dead lies in peace.

“الْمُسْتَوْدَعُ” (*al-mastauda*): the place where something is kept safely.

The Quran has mentioned the dynamic and static condition of every living thing i.e. every living thing evolves in steps: see (11:6), (6:99)

The rule about the organic evolution is that everything stays in a certain place and state for sometime, and then from there it evolves to the next stage, and thus evolves to its completion. These places at which it in a way stops, are its stations, but even in this station a thing is not entirely static. Changes keep taking place in it, but that change is so imperceptible that we do not feel it. We feel the change when it has actually taken place and visibly manifests itself. We call it the next stage of that thing.

“وَدَّعَهُ” (*wada'ahu*), “وَدَّعَا” (*wad'aa*), “وَدَّعَهُ” (*wadda-u*), “تَوَدَّيْعَا” (*taudee'aa*): to say goodbye to someone, to see somebody off.

“وَدَّعَ” (*wada'u*) along with “دَّعَا” (*da'atah*) means “luxurious living”. The one who sees somebody off prays that “may God keep the traveller protected from the travails of the journey and makes him reach his destination comfortably”. Later this word came to mean “send somebody off” or “see somebody off”.

Later it came to mean “to give up” or “to leave” {R}.

The Quran says:

93:3	Your Sustainer has not forsaken you, and neither is he displeased with you	مَا وَدَّعَكَ رَبُّكَ وَمَا قَلَىٰ
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33:48	to give up or leave alone.	دَعَا إِذَا نَعِمَ
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Ibn Faris says it basically means “to arrive” and “be familiar”.

Muheet says the basic meaning of this root is “to come close” and “to be attracted” {*M*}.

“وَدَقَّ إِلَيْهِ” (*wadaqa ilaih*): came closer to him.

“وَدَقَّ الْمَطَرُ” (*wadaqal matar*): it rained from the sky.

“الْوَدَقُ” (*al-wadaq*): rain, since it comes from the skies.

“وَدَقَّتِ الدَّابَّةُ” (*wadaqatid da’abbatu*) and “اَسْتَوْدَقْتُ” (*astadaqat*): for the female four-legged to secrete as the male wants, or according to his wish.

“وَدَقَّ” (*wadqun*): the mist that is seen when it is raining hard.

“وَدِيقَةٌ” (*wadeeqah*): the shimmering in the air due to heat {*R*}.

Taj says that every type of rain whether it is light or heavy is called “وَدَقَّ” (*wadq*).

The Quran has used the word “الْوَدَقُ” (*al-wadq*) to mean rain, and when it comes out of the clouds (24:43).

“وَدَّيْ الشَّيْءُ وَدِيًا” (*wadash shaiy-u wadua*): the thing started flowing {*T*}.

“الْوَدْيُ” (*al-waadi*): the place where water flows. This is the word’s real meaning, but later it started meaning the wide land between two mountains {*R*}.

The plural is “وَدِيَّةٌ” (*audiyah*) as in (46:24). Later it figuratively began to mean “way” or “belief”. “Style” was also called “وَادٍ” (*waad*).

“فُلَانٌ فِي وَادٍ غَيْرِ وَادِيكَ” (*fulaanun fi waadin ghairi waadika*): that man has a way which is different than yours {*R*}.

The Quran says about emotional people:

26:25	Do you not see how they act like a thirsty camel who needs satiation and wanders from one concept to another in search of the concept that will satisfy them	أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّهُمْ فِي كُلِّ وَادٍ يَهِيمُونَ
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For more details see heading (*Sh-Ain-R*).

“أَوْدَاهُ” (*audah*): he killed him {*R*}.

“أَوْدَى الرَّجُلُ” (*audar rajul*): the man was killed {*T*}.

“الْدِّيَّةُ” (*ad-diyah*): the wealth which is given as compensation by the murderer to the heirs of the murdered {*M*}, i.e. money given in compensation for taking a life (4:92).

“الْوَذْرَةُ” (*al-wazrah*): small piece of meat which is boneless.

“ذَرَهُ” (*zarhu*): to give it up or leave it.

“هُوَ يَذَرُهُ” (*huwa yazaruhu*): he gives it up, the word is alternate of “تَرَكَ” (*tarak*) which means “to give up”.

The Quran says:

73:11	Leave those (who rebel against our laws) to us (leave them to us, do not worry about them, our law will deal with them)	وَذَرْنِي وَالْمُكَذِّبِينَ
2:234	and leave their wives behind	وَيَذَرُونَ أَزْوَاجًا

“وَرِثَ أَبَاهُ” (*warisa abah*): he became heir to his father.
 “أَوْرَثَهُ” (*aurasahu*), “أَبُوهُ” (*abuh*): his father made him the heir.
 “الْوَرِثُ” (*al-wirs*), “الْإِرْثُ” (*al-irs*), “الْتَرَاثُ” (*at-turaas*): inheritance.

Some say that “وَرِثَ” (*wars*) and “مِيرَاثُ” (*meeras*) is in relation to inheritance or wealth and “إِرْثُ” (*irs*) is with relation to descent.

“الْوَارِثُ” (*al-wars*): a fresh thing.
 “الْوَارِثُ” (*al-waaris*) is a Godly trait {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means “to possess a thing and then for that thing to be transferred to others”. Thus for God to be “الْوَارِثُ” (*al-waaris*) is explained.

Raghib says real inheritance is something that does not impose any responsibility, and for which a man is not held accountable. Anything which is acquired without any effort is called “قَدُورِثٌ كَذَا” (*qad warisa kaza*). To give someone as gift to someone is called “أَوْرَثَ” (*awras*). Inheritance is not confined to wealth only.

“وَرِثْتُ عِلْمًا مِنْ فُلَانٍ” (*waristu ilman min fulanin*) also means that “I benefited from that man in knowledge” {R}.

Zikriah when he had prayed to God to grant him a son, said:

19:6	Who will inherit me from the family of <i>Yaqub</i> ?	يَرِثُنِي وَ يَرِثُ مِنْ آلِ يَعْقُوبَ
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Here he meant inheritance of knowledge, not messenger hood, that is, messenger-hood is not hereditary as inheritance in other things is.

Messenger-hood is granted by Allah only. It is another matter that Allah may select a man for messenger-hood whose father was also a messenger. This post was given to the son not as an inheritance but by Allah’s own criterion in making such a decision.

Surah *Al-Bagrah* says “الْوَارِثُ” (*al-waaris*) in verse (2:233). Here it means “inheritance”.

Surah *Aal-e-Imran* says:

3:180	And the heritage of heaven and earth is for Allah	وَلِلَّهِ مِيرَاثُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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Here “مِيرَاثُ” (*meeraas*) means “country as inheritance”.

The Quran says:

89:16	These people collect the inheritance and gobble it up	وَتَأْكُلُونَ التُّرَاثَ أَكْلًا لَمًّا
7:43	This is the heaven which has been made your inheritance as a consequence of for your (good) deeds	بَلَّغَكُمْ الْجَنَّةَ الَّتِي أَوْثَقْتُمُوهَا بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ

This means that heaven has been promised in return for your righteous deeds. This shows that not only those who inherit have been called as heirs, but also those who get the return for their labour and hard work have also been called heirs. This is an important point noted by the Quran for our consideration. Inheritance of the earth too has this meaning, for which capability is one of the must conditions (21:105).

“الْوَرْدُ” (*al-ward*): the flowers of any tree. The singular is “وَرْدَةٌ” (*wardah*). Later this word was mostly used for the rose {*T, M, R*}, and even later to mean “the colour red or pink”.

The Quran says:

55:37	It will turn red like <i>dihaan</i>	فَكَانَتْ وَرْدَةً كَالدِّهَانِ
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For the meaning of “دِهَانٌ” (*dihaan*) see heading (*D-He-N*).

“الْوَرْدُ” (*al-wird*): port or jetty where animals drink, or for animals to reach the drinking spot, whether it is entered or not {*T, M, R*}.

Ibn Faris too says that this word means to reach something, like people or animals who reach their drinking spots.

“الْمَوَارِدُ” (*al-mawarid*): water hole.

“الْمَوْرِدَةُ” (*al-mawridah*), “الْوَارِدَةُ” (*al-waridah*): path, or specifically that path which leads to a water hole (water source).

“الْوَرْدُ” (*al-waarid*): one who reaches the water hole {*T, M, R*}, or the man who reaches the water hole first and draws water for the animals in the caravan to drink {*T, M, R*}.

“الْوَارِدُ” (*auradahu*): brought him to the drinking spot.

“الْوَرْدَةُ” (*al-wareed*): the vein to the heart {*T, M, R*}.

Surah *Hoodh* says:

11:98	How execrable is the drinking spot at which they land	وَيُسْأَلُ الْوَرْدُ الْمَوْرُودُ
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Surah *Maryam* says:

19:86	We will drive the criminals to the <i>jahannam</i> like animals are driven to their wale hole.	وَنُسْأَلُ الْمُجْرِمِينَ إِلَى جَهَنَّمَ وَرِدًا
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Surah *Yusuf* has used the word “وَارِدٌ” (*waarid*) to mean “one who goes ahead of the caravan and brings water (12:19).

Surah *Maryam* says about the *jahannam*:

19:71	There is nobody among you who can be <i>waarid</i> on her	وَإِنْ مِنْكُمْ إِلَّا وَارِدُهَا
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This verse is taken to generally mean that all human beings will first enter hell, then the believers will be taken out and the unbelievers will remain there. As confirmation of this, the next verse (19:72) is presented. But this concept is wrong (not compatible with the rest of the Quran) because there is nothing to suggest that anybody will be taken out of “جَهَنَّمَ” (*jahannam*) which is not a place or abode which one can leave after paying for his crimes or bad deeds. It is actually a state in which one trails behind in the evolutionary process, so getting out of this state after leaving this life is impossible.

It is for this reason that the Quran has said about the *momineen*:

21:101	They will be kept away from it, so far that they will not even be able to hear its sound	أُولَئِكَ عَنْهَا مُبْعَدُونَ لَا يَسْمَعُونَ حَسِيسَهَا
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Therefore the aforesaid verse (19:71) refers not to all humans but only to those who made wrong choices in this life and who do not believe in the accountability and the life after death.

Verse (19:72) says “ثُمَّ نُنَجِّي الَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا” (*summa nunajjil lazeenat taqu*). Here “ثُمَّ” (*summa*) does not mean “after this”, but is in relation to another thing. See heading *Summa*. Hence “نِجَاتٌ” (*nijaat*) also means “to protect” or “to keep safe from punishment”. See heading (*N-J-W*).

But if one insists that in (19:71) “مِنْكُمْ” (*minkum*) means “all humanity”, i.e. the believers as well as the unbelievers, then it is not necessary to enter “” (*wird*). It only means “to reach a certain spot”. This means that in order to reach *jannah* one will have to pass through travails whether worldly, or in the life hereafter. This criterion will have to be passed through at every step in this world to reach heaven. Anyone who is found weak or who escapes his trial, will land in the destruction of the *jahannam*. He who is stolid in misery and is careful, will be protected from this hell. At several places in the Quran it has been said that in order to reach *jannah* one will have to pass through travails, as in (2:214), (3:141), (9:16), and (33:10). This does not mean that in the life hereafter one will have to go through travails first and only then he will be able to enter *jannah*. It means that the messengers of truth will face travails at the hands of the opponents in this world. He who bears these travails of opponents of truth will be qualified to go to *jannah*. Such a person will go straight to *jannah* after death. Whether one goes to *jannah* or *jahannam*, is decided by the deeds one does in this world.

This can be said philosophically that the creative process is such that every creative idea before being manifested as a concrete thing is in a state of internal chaos or an internal churning. These are called labour pains. A successful genius is one who comes out of this internal conflict successfully, while the unsuccessful is lost in the struggle. If we look at history we find many unsuccessful thinkers or philosophers who are found to have been engulfed in this conflict. Messenger- hood is above this process, because it is not created by the messenger’s own thoughts.

W-R-Q ورق

Ibn Faris says it basically means goodness and riches, and muddy color.

“الْوَرَقُ” (*al-waraq*): the leaves of a tree.

“وَرَقَةً” (*warq*): means one leaf {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

6:59	And even a leaf does not fall without Him knowing of it.	وَمَا تَسْقُطُ مِنْ وَرَقَةٍ
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Abu Abeeda says that “الْوَرَقُ” (*al-waraq*) means “silver”.

Abul Haisham says “الْوَرَقُ” (*waraqn*), “الْوَرِقُ” (*al-wariq*) and “الرِّقَّةُ” (*ar-riqah*) means silver coin {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:19	So send one of you with the silver coin of yours	فَابْعَثُوا أَحَدَكُمْ بِوَرِقِكُمْ
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Muheet says that in the olden days “وَرَقُ” (*waraq*) meant the skins which were used for writing, i.e. parchments {*T, M*}. This leads to the meaning of leaves of a page or pages of a book.

W-R-Y وری

This root means both “to hide” and also “to be manifest”. It has both connotations of “hiding” as well as “making manifest”, like fire is a potential hidden within flint stones. When the fire comes out of them, it becomes manifest.

“وَرَتِ النَّارُ” (*waratin naar*): the fire flared up.

“أُورِيَ النَّارُ” (*auran naar*): the fire was stoked.

“وَرَّاهُ تَوْرِيَةً” (*warrahu taureeyah*): hid him.

“وَرَّى الزُّنْدُ” (*araz zanad*): fire erupted out of the flint stones.

“وَرَّى الْخَبْرَ” (*warral khabar*): hid the real thing and expressed it in another way {*T*}.

“وَرَّاهُ” (*waaraahu*): hid it.

“يُورِي” (*yuwaari*): hide (5:31).

“تَوَارَى” (*tawaari*): hidden {T}.
 “تَوْرِيَّةٌ” (*tasuriyah*): place to hide
 “الْوَرَاءُ” (*al-wara’u*): grandson {Ibn Qateeba}.

11:71	<i>Ibrahim</i> got the premonition of his son <i>Ishaq</i> and beyond <i>Ishaq</i> a grandson in the person of <i>Yaqoob</i> .	وَمِنْ وَرَاءِ إِسْحَاقَ يَعْقُوبُ
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Torah is supposed to be from this root according to some {T}. If so, it would then mean “a thing which can give fire or light”. For the meaning of Torah the Book, see heading **Taurah**.

“وَرَاءَ ذَلِكَ” (*wara’a zaalik*), “سِوَى ذَلِكَ” (*siwa zaalik*): something beyond it {M}.

The Quran says:

2:91	deny anything that is beyond it too	وَيَكْفُرُونَ بِمَا وَرَاءَهُ
56:71	have you ever wondered about the fire which you light up	أَفَرَأَيْتُمُ النَّارَ الَّتِي تُؤْرَقُونَ
100:2	the horse whose hooves send out sparks when they hit the ground	فَالْمُورِقَاتِ فَدَحًا

“وَرَاءُ” (*wara’u*), “وَرَى” (*waryun*): both in front and back {T}. At different places in the **Quran**, the meanings of this word will be determined as per the context.

W-Z-R و ز ر

“الْوَزْرُ” (*al-wazar*): high and safe mountain, a mountain which can be sought for refuge, any sanctuary {T}.

The Quran says:

75:11	There is no place where they can run away to and seek refuge	كَلَّا لَا وَزَرَ
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“الْوِزْرُ” (*al-wizr*): heavy load or burden, very big responsibility. The plural is “أَوْزَارٌ” (*auzaar*).

Ibn Faris says this root has two meanings. One is of “sanctuary” and the second one is “heaviness in something” or “something being burden-some”.

“وَزَرَ” (*wazar*): he lifted the load.
 “وَاَزَرَ” (*waazir*): one who lifts the load {T}.

The Quran says:

6:165	No one will lift someone else’s burden in the hereafter:	لَا تَزِرُ وَزِرَّتُهُ وَزِرُّ أُخْرَى
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Everyone will have to fulfil his own responsibility and nobody shall be punished or rewarded for someone else’s deeds. Nobody will have a share in the returns of any one’s deeds. This is a great principle of the Law of requital which the Quran has described here. One will be responsible for himself only and get the returns for his own deeds only, unlike today’s happenings in which somebody labours and somebody else reaps the benefits. Somebody commits a crime and others pay for it. One makes the mistakes and others pay for it. This all will not happen in a Quranic society or in the life hereafter.

“لَا تَزِرُ وَزِرَّتُهُ وَزِرُّ أُخْرَى” (*la taziru waazirah wazir ukhra*): he who sows will also reap will be the unchangeable principle there.

“وَزِيرٌ” (*wazirun*), “مُؤَاَزِرٌ” (*muwaazir*): he who is responsible, he who shares the burden.

Raghib says “المُؤَاوَرَّة” (*al-muwazarah*) means “assistance” and “وَزِيرٌ” (*wazir*) means “assistant” as well as “someone who shares the burden or bears the load of the leader” {*R*}.

The Quran says:

20:29	Make someone share the burden from among my family	وَأَجْعَلْ لِي وَزِيرًا مِّنْ أَهْلِي
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“أَوْزَارُ الْحَرْبِ” (*auzaar-ul-herb*): the weapons or implements of war (47:4).

The Quran says the *momineen* go to war or do battle so that war gives up its weapons, or that peace is established, so there can be peace in the world.

47:4	until war gives up its weapons (or lays down/surrenders its weapons)	حَتَّى تَضَعَ الْحَرْبُ أَوْزَارَهَا
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W-Z-Ain و ز ع

“وَزَعُهُ” (*waza'tuhu*), “أَزَعُهُ” (*waza'uhu*), “وَزَعًا” (*waz'aa*): I stopped him, prevented him.

“فَاتَّزَعُ” (*fattaza'a*): so he stopped.

“الْوَازِعُ” (*al-waazih*): someone who prevents or stops. It is also used to mean leader or ruler. It also means “someone who enforces the law” and also “an army strategist” and “administrator” or “commander” {*T, R*}.

Surah *An-Namal* says about the armies of *Suleman*:

27:17	They were organized and very orderly	فَهُمْ يُوزَعُونَ
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It means that they were administered that they obeyed orders, and were never rebellious, nor did they ever oppress anyone.

The same Surah relates the prayer of *Suleman*:

27:19	O my Benefactor, stop me all from the things which prevent me from thanking you for your Benevolence, give me the courage to use all my capabilities towards the path ordained by you.	رَبِّ أَوْزِعْنِي أَنْ أَشْكُرَ نِعْمَتَكَ
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Scholars say that here “أَوْزِعْنِي” (*au zi'ni*) means “the power”, “the understanding”, and “to make fond of something”. When someone is prevented from following the wrong path, then it means that he is given the capability of following the right path or given the guidance.

Surah *As-Sajdah* says about the dwellers of *jahannum*:

41:19	They will be stopped	فَهُمْ يُوزَعُونَ
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For its meaning, see heading *Jaheem* under (*J-H-M*).

W-Z-N و ز ن

“الْوِزْنُ” (*al-wazn*): to weigh something with a hand, to assess something with a hand {*R*}.

“وَزْنٌ” (*wazn*): for something to be light or heavy.

“وَزْنٌ” (*wazn*): for one thing to be equal in weight to another {*Lais*}

“وَزَنَ” (*wazan*), “يَزِنُ” (*yazin*): to weigh, to weigh and give {*T*}.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is stolidity and balance and proportion, and also for making two things equal in weight.

The Quran has given a lot of importance to “وَزْنٌ” (*wazn*) and given it a particular meaning. By deliberating on the universe one can easily understand that this whole system is founded on balance. If the balance between things is disturbed, then the whole system will go awry.

55:7	God has created the universe and kept a balance in everything	وَالسَّمَاءَ رَفَعَهَا وَوَضَعَ الْمِيزَانَ
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The mutual gravity between planets is just one example of this great fact. Since man is also a part of the universe, it is essential that his world too carries this balance.

55:8	In order that you do not transgress balance	الَّا تَطْغَوْا فِي الْمِيزَانِ
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Social and economic life always follows the principle:

55:9	Uphold the social and economic balance and never let the social balance go awry	وَأَقِمْ وَزْنَ بِالْقِسْطِ وَلَا تُخْسِرُوا الْمِيزَانَ
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Obviously this balance cannot be upheld simply by having a law which in fact is words. It is also necessary to formulate a practical system which upholds this value. This is why the Quran has not only given us the code of laws but has also given us “الْمِيزَانُ” (*al-meezaan*) or the practical system to establish this balance. In other words:

57:25	A system which truly determines the ‘weight’ or value of everything.	وَ أَنْزَلْنَا مَعَهُمُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْمِيزَانَ لِيَقُومَ النَّاسُ بِالْقِسْطِ
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But no system in the world can be stable if not backed by power or authority and therefore it is said:

57:25	for this we have given you the iron (or the sword)	وَ أَنْزَلْنَا الْحَدِيدَ
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This is what a true Quranic system is, i.e. the code of permanent laws from Allah and a system in order to establish this code, and the sword too (was given) in order to implement this system. About iron it is said:

57:25	Its strength does away with the forces or elements which create chaos and disharmony in society	فِيهِ بَأْسٌ شَدِيدٌ وَمَنَافِعُ لِلنَّاسِ
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Thus this strength is the cause for the benefit of mankind. The characteristics of this system is that anything acquired in it is begotten according to one’s efforts and deeds:

101:9	He whose scale of intent and (good) deeds tips will live a luxurious life and whoever’s scale is light (as against the other scale) will live a life of misery and ignominy	فَأَمَّا مَنْ ثَقُلَتْ مَوَازِينُهُ فَهُوَ فِي عِيشَةٍ رَاضِيَةٍ وَأَمَّا مَنْ خَفَّتْ مَوَازِينُهُ فَأُمُّهُ هَاوِيَةٌ
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“مَوَازِينُ” (*mawazeen*) is the plural of “مِيزَانٌ” (*meezaan*). In this system everything will be weighted (or valued) correctly (7:8).

“وَالْوِزْنَ يَوْمَ الْحَقِّ” (*wal wazni yau maizinil haq*): and all the efforts which are against the system will become unsuccessful:

18:105	the balance will not be raised for those who worked against the system as there will be nothing to weigh	فَلَا تَعْمَلْ لَهُمْ يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ وِزْنًا
15:19	according to a particular proportion	وَ أَتَيْنَا فِيهَا مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ مَوْزُونٍ

“وَزِينُ الرَّأْيِ” (*wazeenar raya*): a man with a very correct and weighty opinion.

“رَاجِحُ الْوِزْنِ” (*raajij-ul-wazn*): a man who’s opinion is very intelligent and wise.

“أَوْزَنُ الْقَوْمِ” (*auzan-ul-qaum*): the best or most respected person in the nation {M}.

”الْوَسْطُ“ (*al-wast*): the middle part of anything, or the point which is equidistant from both sides.
 ”وَسْطُ الشَّمْسِ“ (*wusutush shams*): for the sun to be in the middle of the sky.
 ”مُوسِطُ الْبَيْتِ“ (*musitul bayt*): that thing which is located in the middle of a house {T}.

Muheet says that ”الْوَسْطُ“ (*al-wasat*) and ”الْوَسْطُ“ (*al-wast*) is the middle point which is equidistant from all sides {M}.

Since mean point is taken to be an average therefore this takes into account the extremes i.e. lows and highs therefore this word is used to mean something pleasant and good.

”وَاسِطَةُ الْقِلَادَةِ“ (*waasitul qilaadah*): the middle part of a necklace which is usually the best part.
 ”وَاسِطَةُ الدَّنَانِيرِ“ (*wasatatut dananeer*): the best coin {T}.
 ”الْوَاسِطَةُ“ (*al-waasitah*): medium, intermediary and the reason or cause for anything {M}.
 ”الْوَسِيطُ“ (*al-waseet*): intermediary who intervenes between two opponents {T}.

The Quran says about the horses in a battle:

100:5	they enter the ranks of the enemies	فَوَسَّطْنَاهُ بِهِ جَمْعًا
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The Quran says about the nation of the **Muslims**:

2:143	Thus we have made you a balanced community so that you guard the conduct of all mankind	وَكَذَٰلِكَ جَعَلْنَاهُمْ أُمَّةً وَسَطًا لِّنُكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ
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For a nation to be able to do this it must be international in its status and equidistant from every nation. So that everyone is equal in its eyes, just as the centre is at an equal distance from every point within a circle. It is obvious then that this position can be attained only by a nation which never moves an inch away from justice. Only such a nation can oversee the deeds of mankind. Thus ”أُمَّةً وَسَطًا“ (*ummati wast*) means a nation which enjoys a central position internationally which oversees the deeds of all nations internationally and resolves all international disputes with full justice. The Quran had fixed this place for the nation of the **Muslims**. It is noteworthy that the Quran had suggested this system for the resolution of international conflicts at a time when the world was even unaware of the concept of the internationalism.

”وَسْعٌ“ (*wasia*), ”يَسْعُ“ (*yasa'u*), ”سَعَةٌ“ (*sa'ah*): to have the power, the capability, the right.
 ”مَا أَسْعُ ذَٰلِكَ“ (*ma as'a-u zaalik*): I do not have the power to do this.
 ”هَٰذَا الْإِنَاءُ يَسْعُ عِشْرِينَ كَيْلًا“ (*haazal ina'u yasa'u ishreena kaila*): this pot has the capacity to contain twenty measures.
 ”الْوَاسِعُ“ (*al-waasi'o*), ”الْوَسِيعُ“ (*alwasee'u*): wide, vast.
 ”الْوَسْعُ“ (*al-was'u*), ”الْوَسْعُ“ (*al-wis'u*), ”الْوَسْعُ“ (*al-wus'u*) and ”السَّعَةُ“ (*as'sa'ah*): abundance of sustenance, well-being, power and capacity.
 ”الْوَسَاغُ“ (*al-wasaa'u*): a horse which gallops {T}.

Ibn Faris says the meaning of this word is “opposite to poverty and strictness”.

Raghib says ”وَسْعٌ“ (*wusuh*) is the power which is slightly more than needed for the work assigned.

The Quran says:

2:286	God only assigns work to man which is within the capability he possesses to do the work	لَا يَكْلِفُ اللَّهُ نَفْسًا إِلَّا وُسْعَهَا
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”الْمُوسِعُ“ (*al-wasih*): one of the attributes of Allah {T}.

The Quran uses “المُسْعُ” (*al-musih*) opposite to “المُقْتَرُ” (*al-muqteer*) in (2:236), which means “he who receives abundance in sustenance”. The same meaning is in Surah *An-Noor*:

24:22	well to do people	أُولُو السَّعَةِ
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The Quran says:

51:47	We are the possessor of Vastness (abundance). (We possess great power and capability and We also grant abundance in sustenance)	إِنَّا لَمُوسِعُونَ
2:255	His knowledge encompasses the entire universe (not only knowledge but also his Mercy and Benevolence) (40:7).	وَسِعَ كُرْسِيُّهُ السَّمُوتَ وَالْأَرْضَ
2:286 6:153 7:42 23:62	Allah's orders do not benefit Him (They are there only so that (by following them) the human personality develops, the power or the capability of man expands, he gains expansion and development)	لَا يَكْلَفُ اللَّهُ نَفْسًا إِلَّا وُسْعَهَا
7:42	abundance is a life of heaven	أُولَئِكَ أَصْحَابُ الْجَنَّةِ

This verse refers to the abundance or happiness in this life as well as the development in the human personality which in the life hereafter enables man to traverse higher stages of evolution. This is heaven which encompasses the heavens and the earth (57:21).

Raghib writes that verse (2:286), (6:153), (7:42), (23:62) means that “this is the fruit of following Allah’s guidance”, i.e. “to be in heaven”.

In support of this meaning at another place it is said:

2:185	Allah only orders that which is not beyond man’s capacity	يُرِيدُ اللَّهُ بِكُمُ الْيُسْرَ وَلَا يُرِيدُ بِكُمُ الْعُسْرَ
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This is the general meaning attributed to this verse, but in certain places the former meaning seems more appropriate, which is to live according to the teachings of the Quran. This results in the development of the human personality and in turn expands a person’s abilities and understanding.

W-S-Q و س ق

“وَسَقَ” (*wasqa*), “يَسِقُ” (*yasiq*), “وَسْقًا” (*wasqa*): to join things, to gather different things, to carry a load, to take something inside.

“وَسَقَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*wasqaartin naaqah*): she-camel kept the sperm in its womb and closed the womb’s mouth, i.e. became pregnant.

“اِسْتَوْ سَقَتِ الْاِبِلُ” (*istausaqatil ibl*): the camels gathered together {*T, R*}.

Nawab Siddiq Hasan Khan writes that the words in which *W-S-Q* appear have the connotation of intensity and gathering {*Al-ilm-ul-Ashqaaq*}.

IbnFaris says the basic meaning is to pick something up.

The Quran says:

84:17	night and everything which it gathers (darkness, moon and the stars)	وَاللَّيْلِ وَمَا وَسَقَ
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“وَسَقَ” (*wasq*): a camel load, or sixty.

“اِتِّسَاقَ” (*ittisaaq*): to get everything and for its elements to gather {*R*}.

The Quran says:

84:14	For the moon to be full	وَالْقَمَرَ إِذَا اتَّسَقَ
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“اِتَّسَقَ الْقَمَرُ” (*ittisaaqul qamar*): for the moon to be full, complete and even. This condition prevails from the 13th to the 16th night of the month.

W-S-L و س ل

“اَلْوَسِيْلَةُ” (*al-waseelah*): to reach something eagerly with liking, according to the meaning this word is more particular than the word “اَلْوَصِيْلَةُ” (*waseelah*) (with a *Saad*) because “وَسِيْلَةُ” (*waseelah*) with a *Seen* means “to reach something eagerly” while “وَصِيْلَةُ” (*waseelah*) with a *Saad* only means “to reach something” {*R*}. It also means “status”, “value” and “high rank” {*R*}. It also means “anything through which closeness to something is acquired”.

“قُرْبَةً” (*qurbah*): to be near somebody or close to someone with regard to rank or place {*T, M*}.

“تَوَسَّلَ اِلَيَّ بِكَذَا” (*tawassala ilaiyya bikaza*): he came close to me through that thing {*Ibn Qateeba*}.

Taj and *Muheet* say “وَسِيْلَةُ” (*waseelah*) with a *Seen*, mean “rank, stage, closeness, and relation”.

“تَوَسَّلَ اِلَىٰ بِكَذَا” (*tawassala ilal laahi tawussala*): he did something due to which he became close to Allah.

“وَسِيْلَةُ” (*al-waasil*): to acquire someone’s closeness eagerly {*T, M*}.

There is a verse in Surah *Al-Ma'idah* who’s wrong (traditional or prevalent meaning) has turned a *Deen* like Islam into a personality cult.

This verse is:

5:35	O’ you who Believe, adopt <i>taqwa</i> of Allah and seek ‘ <i>waseela</i> ’ towards him, and struggle in His path so that you may be successful	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ وَابْتَغُوا إِلَيْهِ الْوَسِيلَةَ وَجَاهِدُوا فِي سَبِيلِهِ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ
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I have let the word “*waseela*” remain intact because that is the prevalent meaning. According to the meanings of the word “*waseela*” that I have given earlier, the meaning of this verse would be: “Believers, protect (or observe) the laws of Allah, and seek rank or closeness to Allah”. The way to do it to struggle (to follow) in His path at your utmost, and thus you will be successful in attaining the purpose of life. In other words, this is the way to attain position with Allah and continue struggling in this way.

If this word, “*waseela*”, is translated to mean “means” (as it is generally done), then the verse would mean “seek the means or medium through which you can acquire rank or closeness to Allah, and struggle in this path”. In both meanings the meaning is the same, that is, “struggle or conduct jihad purely for Allah’s *Deen* and this will make you close to Allah. But generally this verse is taken to mean that in order to reach close to Allah, certain “means” or medium is required, and that *waseela* or means is thought to be one’s religious godfather or priest. Therefore one cannot get closer to Allah without this godfather or mentor figure.

When “*waseela*” was taken to mean the “means” or “mentor”, “*jaahidu*” is taken to mean “jihad” against one’s self, which is termed as the greatest jihad or struggle. This would mean that the way of life which has been revealed to us to banish idol worship by establishing a link directly between man and God through the *Quran* has now become advocate of seeking some man’s intervention on behalf of people with God.

Allah had announced that:

2:186	when my workers ask you (O, messenger) about Me, then tell them that I am close to them. I reply to, or respond to anybody who calls me (for help)	أَجِيبْ دَعْوَةَ الدَّاعِ إِذَا دَعَانِ
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But for this there is the condition that:

2:186	They should be faithful to Me, and have faith upon Me, so that they are guided (to the right path)	فَلْيَسْتَجِيبُوا إِلَىٰ وَلِيِّهِمْ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْشُدُونَ
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Hence the issue is very clear. Anybody who has faith on the laws of Allah and obeys them, gets the guidance for which people seek a spiritual guide. There is no such spiritual guide other than Allah himself. (18:17). His laws can be obeyed by establishing His laws in practice. The characteristic of this system is that, no other power intervenes between God and his servants. This is the freedom from all else for enforcing which the Messenger **Muhammed** had been sent (7:157). But instead of enjoying that freedom we bind ourselves with the chains of personality cults so that no part of our thought or deed was allowed to remain free. Remember, man can only exist with his head raised high when he instead of bowing to human beings, bows to Allah's laws only.

W-S-M و س م

"الْوَسْمُ" (*al-wasm*): to brand with a branding iron.
 "الْوَسَامُ" (*al-wisaam*): the mark which is so branded.
 "وَسَمَ" (*wasama*), "يَسِمُ" (*yasimu*), "وَسْمًا" (*wasma*): to brand an animal.
 "الْسِّمَّةُ" (*as-simah*): sign, brand.
 "فُلَانٌ مَّوْسُومٌ بِالْخَيْرِ" (*fulanun masumun bil-khair*): that man has a mark of goodness.
 "مَوْسِمُ الْحَجِّ" (*masimul hajj*): the time which is fixed for hajj.
 "تَوَسَّمُ" (*tawassum*): comprehension and understanding.
 "الْوَسْمِيُّ" (*al-wasmi*): the first rain of spring (which signifies beauty and life).

The Quran says:

28:16	we will brand his nose (insult him)	سَنَسِمْهُ عَلَىٰ الْخُرْطُومِ
15:75	It has indications for those who have comprehension or understanding, for those who try to understand things from its signs	إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّمَنْ تَوَسَّمٰنَ

W-S-N و س ن

"الْوَسْنُ" (*al-wasn*), "الْسِّنَةُ" (*as-sinah*): the beginning of sleep or the grogginess of sleep. The next part is "نَوْمٌ" (*naum*). It also means "unawareness".
 "هُوَ فِي سِنَةٍ" (*huwa fi sinah*): he is unaware {T, R}. It also means "the heaviness of sleep or intensity".

The Quran says about Allah:

2:255	he is not even unaware of anything, leave alone being oblivious	لَا تَاْخُذُهُ سِنَةٌ وَلَا نَوْمٌ
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W-S-W-S و س و س

"الْوَسْوَاسُ" (*al-waswaas*): a slight sound, a hunter's tread, the sound which is produced when treading softly, the slight sound of ornaments while walking is also called so (which conjure up strange things in the mind of the listener) {T, R, M}. It also means for different sort of thoughts to cross the mind, or any indistinct sound in which many voices are heard together, or a speech which is disorganised {T, R, M}.

Raghib says "الْوَسْوَاسُ" (*al-waswas*) is the passing of bad thoughts through the mind.

The Quran says:

7:20	Then the <i>shaitaan</i> put 'waswasa' in their hearts (or minds).	فَوَسْوَسَ لَهُمَا الشَّيْطَانُ
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This means the thoughts of self-interest which emotions produce in the heart (or mind), or which mischievous people incite in someone's mind.

114:4-5	he who comes quietly and puts <i>waswasa</i> in the hearts of people	الْوَسْوَاسِ الْخَنَّاسِ الَّذِي يُوَسْوِسُ فِي صُدُورِ النَّاسِ
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Such people produce chaos in an Islamic society. It has been advised to be careful and chary of them.

“الْوَشْيُ” (*al-weshi*): to make different designs on clot. This is the basic meaning {T}.

Raghib says it means to paint a different colour from a thing's own colors {R}. Thereafter this word came to mean to mix more colours.

“وَشَى النَّمَامُ كَلَامَهُ” (*wush shan namamu kalamah*): the snitcher lied and coloured his talk {T}.

The Quran says about the cow of the **Bani Israel**:

2:71	It is spotless (it does not hold any color that is against its body color)	مُسْلَمَةً لَا شَيْءَ فِيهَا
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“وَصَبَّ” (*wasaba*), “يَصِيبُ” (*yasib*), “وَصُوبًا” (*wusuba*), “أَوْصَبَ” (*au-saba*): for something to last, be durable.

“وَصَبَّ عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*wasaba alal amr*): he concurred and did it beautifully.

“مَفَازَةٌ وَاصِبَةٌ” (*mafaazatun waasibah*): very vast desolate land seemingly without end.

“الْوَصْبُ” (*al-wasab*): sickness that will always remain, not go away.

“الْأَوْصَابُ” (*al-auasab*): patients {T, R}.

The Quran says:

16:52	Everything in the universe is obeying the laws of Allah and is doing this with agreeableness, and has been carried out perennially (It is therefore necessary for man to do same).	وَلَهُ الدِّينُ وَاصِبًا
37:10	Punishment will be mandatory.	وَهُمْ عَذَابٌ وَاصِبٌ

“الْوَصِيدُ” (*al-waseed*): porch, veranda, threshold, a pen made from stones (boundary) for the camels in the mountains {T, R}.

Surah **Al-Kahaf** says that their dog sat with his forelegs in the “وَصِيدٌ” (*waseed*) (18:18). Here it means the portion in front of the cave or the threshold. Threshold makes the meaning clearer:

“أَوْصَدَ الْبَابَ” (*ausadal baaba*) and “أَصَدَهُ” (*asadahu*): he closed the door.

“أَوْصَدَ الْقَدْرَ” (*ausadil qidr*): he covered the pot (with the lid) {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says it basically means to join one thing with another.

Verse (104:8) says “إِنَّهَا عَلَيْهِمْ مُّصَدَّةٌ” (*Innaha alaihim musadah*). For its meaning see heading (A-Sd-D).

“وَصَفَ الشَّيْءَ يَصِفُهُ” (*wasafash shaiya yasifahu*), “وَصْفًا” (*wasfa*): to describe something or its condition.
 “الصِّفَةُ” (*as-sifah*): the condition of something, state, situation {T}.

Ibn Faris says that its basic meaning is to describe something. It also “الصِّفَةُ” (*as-sifah*) is a sign which always accompanies something.

Almost everyone in this world agrees that God is there, but the difference lies in what they think God is or how He is? Nobody’s intellect can tell him for certain as to how or what God is like. God is beyond the comprehension of human intellect, therefore only that can be held true about God which God himself relates, and there can be no other source for what he says but the revelation which in its final form is contained in the Quran. Therefore the concept that the Quran presents about God is the only true one. Any concept that is in conflict with the Quranic concept will not be true.

Therefore, after relating such concepts (that are produced by the human mind) the Quran says:

6:101	God is far above and free of the concepts these people produce about Him	سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى عَمَّا يُصِفُونَ
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This is the reason that the Quran even invites those people (who believe in God) to have faith and accept Islam, so that you have the right concept of God, and this can only be the concept that God has explained about Himself and which is now preserved in the Quran. This is through His attributes. In other words, we are quite incapable of understanding much about God. Nobody who is finite (man) can really understand the infinite (God). Therefore God has only related His attributes, and we can have an idea about Him through these traits. God is All Knowing, Aware, Seer, etc. But God who is all these things, is actually what? We can neither comprehend nor make someone understand. As per the Quran what is detailed in the Quran is enough for the human self-development in this life – it is about what we do in this life with Allah’s attributes serving as a model.

“وَصَلَ” (*wasl*): to join a thing with another, to join. It is the opposite of “cut-off”.
 “أَوْصَلَهُ” (*au-salahu*), “إِصْلًا” (*eesaala*): made it reach it or joined with it. In (2:27) “إِصْلًا” (*weesaal*) has come opposite to “قَطَعَ” (*qat’un*) which means to demean or kill.
 “وَصَلَ الشَّيْءَ” (*wasalash shaiyi*) or “إِلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*ilash shaiyi*): reached that thing.

“وَصَلَ فُلَانٌ رَحِمَهُ” (*wasala fulanun rahimah*) is spoken against “قَطَعَ الرَّحِمَ” (*qata’ar rahim*). For the meaning of “رَحِمَهُ” (*rahima*) see heading (*Q-Th-Ain*).

“الْوَصِيلَةُ” (*al-waseelah*): the goat which gives birth continuously in seven pregnancies to two females in each birth and the seventh time gives birth to one male and one female kid (5:103). Before the Islamic period the Arabs did not slaughter this male kid and the women did not partake the milk of this mother-goat and this goat was left alone or let loose in the name of the deities (as sacred).

Scholars say a female camel instead of a she-goat is meant here {T}. However, this signifies the superstitions that were prevalent there before the advent of Islam.

We say sometimes when some big religious personality passes away that the man has met “وَصَالَ” (*wisaal*). This concept has come from the Hindu concept of *Vedant*, which says that man is part of God which unfortunately has been imprisoned in this corporeal self. After parting with this body, man’s soul will rejoin with its whole (God). For this rejoining the word ‘wisaal’ is used, i.e. that he becomes rejoined with God. This is the teaching of the modern day *Muslims*, or at least in some parts of the muslim world. All these concepts are non-Quranic. Similar is the concept of ‘urs’, which has come from the Christian concept of monasticism, which means “to wed”. Christians believe that the nuns are wedded to Christ

whom they think is God, and in a way they are the brides of God. This concept seems to have made inroads in sufism within the *muslims*, where it is thought that if a religious person or elder dies, he is reunited with God. All such concepts are non-Quranic.

W-Sd-Y و ص ی

“وَصَى الشَّيْءُ بِهِ وَصِيًّا” (*wasash shaiyu bihi wasya*): to be joined, to join.
 “وَصَاهُ بِهِ يَصِيهِ” (*wasahu bihi yasih*): joined it with it.
 “وَصَى النَّبْتُ” (*wasan nabt*): the plants intertwined and entwined each other.
 “أَرْضٌ وَاصِيَةٌ” (*arzun waasiyah*): the land in which the plants are planted close to each other and are intertwined.
 “فَلَاةٌ وَاصِيَةٌ” (*falaatun wasiyah*): the desert which is conjoined to another wasteland {*T, M*}.

Raghib has said that “الْوَصِيَّةُ” (*al-wasiyyah*) means to advise somebody before an event takes place {*R*}. It also means duty and order.

“أَوْصَى” (*ausa*), “يُوصِي” (*yusi*): to declare mandatory and to hand over the matter to somebody.
 “أَوْصَى” (*ausa*) and “وَصَّى” (*wassa*): to make agreement or promises, or to make someone the owner (after one's death).
 “الْوَصِيُّ” (*al-wasi*): one who makes out a will, and also one who is advised.

The Quran says:

2:132	Ibrahim ordered his sons to do it (took this further up to them)	وَوَصَّى بِهَا إِبْرَاهِيمُ بَنِيهِ
4:11	Allah orders you about your children	يُوصِيكُمُ اللَّهُ فِي أَوْلَادِكُمْ

Surah *Yasin* uses the word “تَوْصِيَّةٌ” (*tauseeyah*) in (36:50). Surah *Al-Asr* describes one of the characteristics of the group of *momineen*:

103:3	They advise each other to be patient and follow the right path	تَوَاصَوْا بِالْحَقِّ وَتَوَاصَوْا بِالصَّبْرِ
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But as per the connotation contained in the root's meaning, it also means that due to the truth and stolidity, they are joined together. The cause of mutual bond between them is true and strong. The reason for their being strong is that they share the same ideology of ‘*Iman*’ and work together for the establishment of the system for the good of mankind.

“مُوصٍ” (*moos*): one who makes a will (2:182).

The Quran says:

2:180	Those who face death, and who leave behind them inheritance (or wealth), must make out a will for their parents and other relatives according to the proscribed rule	كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ إِذَا حَضَرَ أَحَدُكُمُ الْمَوْتُ أَنْ تَرَكَ خَيْرَانَ الْوَصِيَّةَ لِلْوَالِدَيْنِ وَالْأَقْرَبِينَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ - حَقًّا عَلَى الْمُتَّقِينَ
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This shows that it is one's duty to make out a will for the parents and other relatives, but if someone cannot make a will due to some reason, or the will does not cover the entire inheritance, then God has apportioned shares. This is the reason that while relating about those shares, the Quran has repeatedly said:

4:11	After completing his will or after repaying any loan	مَنْ بَعْدَ وَصِيَّةٍ يُوصِي بِهَا أَوْ دَيْنٍ
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This order is so plain and straight forward that there is no cause for any deliberation on this, but it is said that inheritance can only be made for one third of the inheritance, as well as for the heirs. A tradition (not any verse of the Quran) is presented in support of this contention, because obviously there can be no hadith that is repugnant or opposed to the Quran. But in order to prove that this tradition is right it is even

said that a hadith can over-rule the Quranic verses. Therefore this hadith has cancelled the relevant verses of the Quran. This concept is a direct contravention of the Quran.

Remember, no verse of the Quran has been cancelled – a detailed study of the Quran indicates that everything contained in the Book is required at some stage of our individual and collective life. No verse within it cancels any other verse nor does anything outside it can cancel any verse within it. Every word of God stands solidly as the truth. For more details see heading **(N-S-Kh)**. Even if the Messenger **Muhammed** had said it, it is possible that due to some exigency the Messenger had advised someone at that time to make out a will for one third of his inheritance in somebody's favour. If that is so then it was a temporary thing and does not enjoy permanence and is not applicable as far as the Quranic injunction is concerned.

Also note that laws about inheritance will be employed only if the deceased has extra wealth. If a society is established in which one hands over his extra wealth to the Quranic system (for the sustenance of others to be distributed by the Quranic state), see heading **(Ain-F-W)**, then there is no question of any inheritance, which is the ultimate objective of the system. The Messenger **Muhammed** himself had done so, neither did he keep wealth more than what he needed nor did he leave an inheritance. He did not accumulate any property nor was there a need to be distributed. Thus the laws of inheritance need not be applied to him. This will be the condition of all **momin**s when a Quranic society is created. Till that time every **momin** should make out a will for the inheritance he leaves behind. It is his duty indeed and he has full right to do with his inheritance as he wills. The fact is that one can understand his affairs himself. A man gave his elder son higher education, sent him to London for education, made him do law, he is now doing well and very happy. Recently another son was born to him, all expense regarding his bringing up, education are still to be made, i.e. will have to be made. According to the law the will he can bequeath all his inheritance to this child, but if this will is not made out then the elder son stands to get half of the inheritance, although his father has already spent a lot on him. After giving the right to will his inheritance as he likes, the Quran has also said that if someone's will is not just, then the court has the right to arbitrate between the heirs according to laws (2:182). The will has been given so much importance by the Quran that in Surah **Al-Mai'dah** it has itself related the procedure for evidencing or witnessing (5:106).

W-Zd-Ain و ض ع

“وَضَعَ الشَّيْءَ مِنْ يَدِهِ يَضَعُهُ” (*wazash shaiyi min baadihi yaza-uhu*): he dropped something from his hand, put it down {**T, R**}.
 “وَضَعَ الشَّيْءَ فِي الْمَكَانِ” (*wazash shaiya fil makaan*): put something somewhere {**T, R**}.

The Quran says:

18:49	And the Book will be placed	وَضَعَ الْكِتَابَ
55:7	And He has set up the balance	وَضَعَ الْمِيزَانَ
3:35	Put him, placed him	وَضَعَ عَنْهُ

“وَضَعُ ثِيَابَ” (*waza'a unhu*): to move away, to remove, to drop (94:2).

“مَوْضِعَ” (*waza-u siyab*): to take off the clothes and lay them down.

“مَوَاضِعَ” (*mawazih*): places, chances.

“مَوْضُوعَةً” (*mauzu'ah*): laid down (88:14).

“وَضَعَتِ النَّاقَةُ” (*waza'atin naaqah*): the camel sped fast.

“وَضَعَ الرَّجُلُ” (*waza'ar rajul*): the man ran.

“أَوْضَعْتُهُ” (*auza'tuhu*): I made him run {**T, R**}.

Surah **At-Taubah** says:

9:47	they would strive to create chaos among you (would work very hard for this)	وَلَا أَوْضَعُوا جُلُكُمُ
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“وَضَنَّهُ” (*wazanah*): he arranged it one over other systematically.
 “الْمَوْضُونَةُ” (*al-mauzunah*): armour, i.e. whose clips are linked to one another, or the thing which jewels are sewn onto, or the thing which has been arranged by layers (i.e. one upon another).
 “سَرِيرٌ مَوْضُونٌ” (*sareerun mauzun*): a double woven bed {T, R, M}.

The Quran says:

56:15	double woven beds (or beds decorated with jewels)	سَرِيرٌ مَوْضُونٌ
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“وَطَّأَهُ” (*watiffahu*), “يَطْؤُهُ” (*yata-uhu*), “وَطْأَ” (*wat’a*): to trample something.
 “وَطِئَ الْمَرْأَةُ يَطِئُهَا” (*wati’al mar’ata yata’uhu*): to have sex with a woman.
 “وَوَطْأَ يَوِطُّ” (*watu’a yautuhu*): to be soft or easy {T, R}.

Ibn Faris says this word basically means to press and make something spread out in order to make it level or smooth.

The Quran says:

48:25	which you trample unknowingly	لَمْ تَعْلَمُوهُمْ أَنْ تَطَئُوهُمْ
33:27	a land which your feet have not trampled	وَأَرْضًا لَمْ تَطَئُوهَا

“الْمَوْطَأُ” (*almauta’uw*) and “الْمَوْطِئُ” (*al-mauti*): a place to put a step
 “وَلَا يَطْءُونَ مَوْطِئًا” (*almauta’uw al-mautia*): they do not walk on such a land (9:120) {T, R}.
 “مُؤَاطَاةٌ” (*muwata’ah*): to follow in the footsteps.
 “رَجُلٌ مُؤَاطَاةُ الْعَقِبِ” (*rajulun muwatta’ul aqib*): a man who is followed in what he says {T, R}.
 “مُؤَاطَاةٌ” (*muwata’uh*): to agree and concur with {T, R}.

The Quran says:

9:37	So that in this way they make it synchronize with the numerical count	لِيُؤَاطُوا عِدَّةً
73:5	To get up at night develops your capabilities and quells rebellious emotions (a man’s will power becomes a mixture or blend of his intent and decision) {M}	إِنَّ نَاشِئَةَ اللَّيْلِ هِيَ أَشَدُّ وَطْأً

This relates to the Messenger *Muhammed* as in the early days of spreading the *Deen* of Allah he used to be busy day and night. To sacrifice one’s rest at night in the achievement of one’s purpose is obvious evidence of keeping one’s emotions under control as continuously thinking rationally within the revealed values of the Quran, especially when this sacrifice is made not for any personal gain but for the good of the mankind.

“الْوِطْرُ” (*al-watar*): need, a need which requires special arrangement to fulfill, a special need {R}.

The Quran has mentioned “قَضَائِ وَطَرٍ” (*qazai witr*) in (33:37) which means “to fulfill the need” i.e. “to cut off relations”, or “to decide that marriage is no more needed-not working”. This is what decision “to cut off relations” means.

“الْوَطَنُ” (*al-want*): homeland. It figuratively also means “the place where cattle and goats are tethered”.
 “وَطَنَ بِهِ” (*watana bihi*), “يَطِنُ” (*yatin*), “أَوْطَنَ” (*autan*): to stay or reside.
 “إِسْتَوْطَنَهُ” (*istaunahu*), “وَأَاطَنَهُ” (*wattanahu*), “وَتَوَطَّنَهُ” (*wattanahu*), “وَتَوَطَّنَ بِهِ” (*tawattan bihi*): he made it his homeland.
 “الْمَوَاطِنُ مِنَ الْحَرْبِ” (*al-watinu minal herb*): battlefield {*T, M*}. The Quran has used this word in this very meaning.

Surah *At-Taubah* states:

9:25	Surely Allah helped you in many battle fields	لَقَدْ نَصَرَكُمُ اللَّهُ فِي مَوَاطِنَ كَثِيرَةٍ
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“وَعَدَ” (*wa’ad*), “يَعِدُ” (*ya’id*), “وَعْدًا” (*wa’d’un*) and “وَعْدُهُ” (*wa’idah*): to make a promise, whether of a good thing or bad. If the good or bad is not specifically mentioned with “وَعَدَ” (*wa’ad*) then it means “a good promise”, and if not then “أَوْعَدَ” (*au’ad*) is used to mean “a promise about a bad thing”.

Lataif-al-Lagha says that “الْمِيعَادُ” (*alme’e’aad*) means “the time or place of the promise” {*T, M*}.

“مَوْعِدٌ” (*mau’id*): promise or pledge, and also the place of promise or the time of the promise {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* uses this word to mean the time of fulfillment (18:58).

“الْوَعِيدُ” (*al-wa’eed*): for the male camel to murmur at the time of attack. This word is used to mean “a threat”.

“أَوْعَدَهُ” (*au’adahu*) and “تَوَاعَدَهُ” (*tawa’adah*): to threaten somebody {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* state “وَأَعَدْنَا مُوسَىٰ” (*wa’adna moosa*) in verse (2:51). This includes both fixing a time period by Allah and for its acceptance by *Moosa*.

“مُؤَاعَدَةٌ” (*muwa’adah*): to have a mutual pact.

“Allah’s promise” means “the results of acting on Allah’s laws which never change”. Similarly unchanging and inevitable are the results of being rebellious to those laws and are called “وَعِيدٌ” (*wa’eed*).

The Quran says that the good results of good deeds are also called “وَعَدَ” (*wa’ad*) as in (24: 55), and for the bad results of wrong deeds too as in (9:68).

Surah *At-Taubah* says:

9:114	This was only due to (in honour of) a promise which he had made.	إِلَّا عَنْ مَوْعِدَةٍ وَعَدَهَا إِيَّاهُ
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Wherever in the Quran it appears that “Allah promises you” or “Allah had promised”, then it will mean the inevitable result that will be produced by acting on Allah’s laws. In other words the phrase is expressing the inevitable result of acting upon His law. It is not like some of us (humans) make promises with each other. This also shows that when it is said that “Allah’s promises are true” then it means that the result of Allah’s laws are inevitable and these can never be otherwise.

“وَعَظَّ” (*wa'az*): to tell someone of the good and bad results of a thing to soften one's heart.

Ibn Faris says with reference to *Khalil*, that “الْوَعْظُ” (*al'wa'iz*) means “style”. It also means to talk of good so that one's heart is softened.

Muheet says it does not mean “to reach” but “to order” i.e. “to order someone to stop him from doing something which will produce bad result”

Raghib says it means such warning in which a threat is also implied {R}.

The Quran has often used the word “مَوْعِظَةً” (*mau'izat*), and even the Quran has been said to be “مَوْعِظَةٌ مِنْ رَبِّكُمْ” (*mau'izatun mir rabbikum*) in (10:57). This includes the meaning “to make others aware of the execrable results of wrong ways and to prevent them, and to order individuals to stop from wrong things within a system”.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:90	Indeed, Allah commands for justice and balance... He admonishes you so that you may take heed.	إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُ بِالْعَدْلِ وَالْإِحْسَانِ --- يَعْظُمُكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَذَكَّرُونَ
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Here the word “*amr*” appears first i.e. first Allah orders you to be just and kind, and “يَعْظُمُكُمْ” (*ya izukum*) appears at the last, therefore for those who are *mumineen* “*amr*” and “*waaz*” is the same thing. Here it must be understood that Allah's order is not the order of some dictator. Allah orders but also explains the purpose of that order, and fairness of the order, as well as its benefit. Order and understanding together constitute “وَعَظَّ” (*waaz*).

Surah *Al-Bagrah* says:

2:231	The fair book (the Quran) which God has revealed is to make you fear of wrong deeds, and thus makes you abstain from them.	وَمَا أُنْزِلَ عَلَيْكُمْ مِنَ الْكِتَابِ وَالْحِكْمَةِ يَعْظُمُكُمْ بِهِ
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For the pious it is “مَوْعِظَةً” (*mau'izat*) (2:66). In any case this book will be used to warn everybody (not just the pious).

About the hypocrites it is said:

4:63	ignore them and keep warning them of the results of their bad deeds in a nice way	فَاعْرِضْ عَنْهُمْ
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As such, in case of “*waaz*” to non-*muslims*, it would mean “advice in respect of invitation towards *Deen*” and for the *muslims*, “the orders contained in the Quran and directions issued by an Islamic System”, the benefits of which have been explained in such a way that one leans towards them.

“وَعَاهُ يَعْجِي وَعِيَا” (*wa aahun ba’ihi wa ya*), “أَوْعَى” (*au’ai*), “يُوعَى” (*yu’ee*), and “إِيعَاءٌ” (*ee’aa*): to safe keep something, memorize, to collect something in a utensil {*T, M*}.

“وَعَى” (*wa’aa*): memorize and to safe keep in memory.

“أَوْعَى” (*au’aa*): to safe keep things {*R, F*}.

“أَلْوَعَاءُ” (*al-wi’aa’u*), the plural of which is “أَوْعِيَةٌ” (*auweeah*) means “the thing (a sack, utensil etc.) in which other things are collected and kept (12:76).

Surah *Al-Ma’arij* says about those who possess capitalist mentality:

70:19	He collects wealth and keep it safe (prevents others from getting to it)	وَجَمَعَ فَأَوْعَى
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Surah *Al-Anshaqaaq* says:

84:42	Allah very well knows whatever they keep safe (or hidden)	وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا يُوعُونَ
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“أُذُنٌ وَإِعِيَّةٌ” (*uznun wa iyah*): i.e. an ear which deliberates on the thing that it hears and does not go out with it (not discloses it) (69:12) {*T, M*}.

Surah *Al-Haqq* says:

69:12	and the remembering ears that remember it	وَتَعِيَهَا أُذُنٌ آيَةٌ
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Ibn Faris writes that it basically means “to peep” and “to jut out”.

“أَلْوَفْدُ” (*al-wafd*): the sand dune whose peak overhangs.

“أَلْوَأْفِدُ” (*al-waafid*): the camel which goes in front of all others.

“أَلْإِيفَادُ” (*al-eefaad*): for something to be high and to overhang, to walk fast, to hurry up.

“هُم عَلَى أَوْفَادٍ” (*hoom ala aufaad*): people who are in a journey.

“أَلْإِيفَادُ” (*al-eefaad*): to send someone as an envoy.

“وَفَدَ فُلَانٌ” (*wafada fulaan*): he went to the king as an envoy {*T*}.

“أَلْوَفْدُ” (*al-wafd*): the people who reach the king’s court for congratulating him on an auspicious occasion {*M*}.

Raghib says “أَلْوَفْدُ” (*al-wafd*) are those people who go to kings for fulfilling their need {*R*}.

Surah *Maryam* says:

19:85	The day We will collect the pious before <i>rahman</i> as “wafd”	يَوْمَ نَحْشُرُ الْمُتَّقِينَ إِلَى الرَّحْمَنِ وَفْدًا
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According to the connotation of the meaning ‘wafd’ encompasses loftiness and greatness, closeness, respect, and the receipt of gifts or accoutrements for nourishment etc. It can also mean that the pious will be kept ahead of all (at the time of rewarding for good deeds). Here too the element of respect is present.

“الْوَفْرُ مِنَ الْمَالِ وَالْمَتَاعِ” (*al-wafru minal maali wal mata*): wealth on a vast scale which does not lack anything.

“وَفَرَ الْمَالُ” (*wafaral maal*): wealth in abundance which is enough.

“أَرْضٌ وَفْرَاءُ” (*ardun wafra*): land which has profuse vegetation.

“وَفَرَهُ، تَوَفَّرَ” (*waffarahu taufeera*): he completed it and requited it.

“الْوَفْرَاءُ” (*al-wafra'u*): a thing which is filled.

“الْوَفْرَةُ” (*al-waafirah*): big tail of a lamb.

“الْمَوْفُورُ” (*al-maufur*): anything which has been completed {*T, R, M*}.

The Quran says:

17:63	full return or compensation (from which nothing has been taken)	جَزَاءٌ مَوْفُورًا
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“وَفَضَ” (*wafad*), “يَفِضُ” (*yafidu*), “وَفْضًا” (*wafda*): he ran quickly.

“اِسْتَوْفَضَ” (*istaufad*): he hurried.

“نَاقَةٌ مِيفَاضٌ” (*naaqatun meefaad*): a fast camel.

“الْاِيفَاضُ” (*al-eefaad*): to pick up the arrows and run fast.

“الْوَفْضَةُ” (*al-wafdatu*): a leather container for arrows which has no wooden part. It also means a sack in which the shepherd keeps his food and other things {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

70:43	as if they are running towards a goal	كَانَتْهُمْ إِلَى نَصْبٍ يُؤْفَضُونَ
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“الْوَفْقُ” (*al-wafq*): for two things to be in tandem, to be in agreement {*T*}.

“أَوْفَقَتِ الْاِئِلُ” (*au-faqatil ibl*): the camels were all equal and stood in a row {*T*}.

“الْاِتِّفَاقُ” (*al-ittifaaq*): for a man's deeds to be according to an estimate or a standard (destiny) {*R*}.

“الْتَوْفِيقُ” (*at-taufiq*): to provide the means which is necessary to attain the goal {*M*}.

“وَفَّقَ بَيْنَ الْقَوْمِ” (*waffaqa bainal qaum*): he arbitrated among the nation {*M*}.

Surah *An-Nisa* says that if a husband and wife are at loggerheads with each other then try to make amends between them:

4:35	Allah will create harmony between them	يُوفِّقُ اللَّهُ بَيْنَهُمَا
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The results of deeds have been called “جَزَاءٌ وَفَاقًا” (*jaza'un wifaaqa*) in Surah *An-Naba* (78:62), i.e. “deed and its result, full consonance”. According to the Quran, good or bad result is the other name for a deed.

Surah *Hood* says:

11:88	to get the required means for attaining Allah's purpose	وَمَا تَوْفِيقِي إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ
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This can only be according to Allah's law. There is no other way this can happen.

“تَوْفِيقًا” (*taufiqan*): to reform and refine, i.e. to make in accordance (4:62).

- ”وَفَى السَّيِّئِ وَفِيًّا“ (*wafash shaiyu wafiyya*): the thing was completed, became excessive or in abundance.
- ”وَفَى وَوَفَى“ (*wafiyyun waaf*): completed and in profusion.
- ”أَوْفَانِي حَقِّي“ (*au faani haqqi*): he fulfilled my rights completely, did not reduce a bit.
- ”وَفَى“ (*waffa*): the foregoing, i.e. to give fully {R, M}.
- ”إِسْتَوْفَى فَلَانَ حَقَّهُ“ (*istaufa fulanun haqqahu*): he fully realized his rights.
- ”الْوَفَى“ (*al-wafiyyu*): the man who fulfills rights and realizes them fully too. It also means “very faithful”.
- ”الْوَفَاءُ“ (*al-wafaa*): to fulfill a promise, to respect an agreement.
- ”الْوَفَاةُ“ (*al-wafaat*): death, i.e. to complete one’s days on earth.
- ”تَوَفَّاهُ اللَّهُ“ (*tawaffah-ul-laah*): Allah gave him death {R, M}.
- ”الْوَفَى“ (*al-waif*): high ground.
- ”الْمُوَافَى“ (*al-muwafi*): something which appears suddenly {R, M}.

In the Quran “إيفاء عهد” (*eefa’ay ahad*) (fulfilling a promise) has come opposite “نقض” (*naqaz*) (breaking of a promise), i.e. fulfilling a pledge has appeared opposite to breaking a pledge (16:91, 3:43).

”وُفِّيَتْ“ (*wuffiyat*) has been explained by ”لَا يَظْلُمُونَ“ (*la yazlamoon*), i.e. “not to fall short of”, or “to be found lacking”.

Surah *Hood* says:

11:109	And indeed We will surely pay them in full of their share without being diminished.	وَأَنَا لَمُوفٍوَهُمْ نَصِيبُهُمْ غَيْرَ مَنقُوصٍ
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This explains ”تَوَفِّيَتْ“ (*taufih*), i.e. to complete without any deduction or reduction.

Surah *An-Nahal* says:

16:70	Allah creates you. Then He gives you death and makes some of you reach old age in which the organs weaken.	وَاللَّهُ خَلَقَكُمْ ثُمَّ يَتَوَفَّاكُمْ وَمِنْكُمْ مَنْ يُرَدُّ إِلَى أَرْدَلِ الْعُمُرِ
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These meanings describe the various phases in a man’s life as childhood, youth and old age, but if ”يَتَوَفَّاكُمْ“ (*yatawaffakum*) is taken to mean “gives you death” then it would actually mean that some people die even before old age is reached and some die after reaching old age.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:61	Until death comes to you and our agents give you death	حَتَّىٰ إِذَا جَاءَ أَحَدَكُمْ الْمَوْتُ تَوَفَّتْهُ رُسُلُنَا
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According to the physical laws created by God, his days are over and he dies.

About Jesus it is said in Surah *Al-Ma’idah*:

5:117	Then when you gave me death, You were overseeing them.	فَلَمَّا تَوَفَّيْتَنِي كُنْتُ أَنتَ الرَّقِيبَ عَلَيْهِمْ
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”مُتَوَفٍّ“ (*mutawaff*): one who gives death.

”إِنِّي مُتَوَفِّيكَ“ (*Inni mutawaffika*): Allah says to Jesus that these people (the opponents) are making schemes to arrest you and crucify you but We are also scheming against them and our plan is surely better than theirs.

3:53	Result of my (Allah’s) scheme will be that they will neither be able to arrest you nor crucify you but you will die your own death (in time)	وَمَكْرُؤًا وَّمَكَرَاللَّهِ وَاللَّهُ خَيْرُ الْمَاكِرِينَ
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History tells us that before they could lay their hands on Jesus, he had migrated from there according to a plan. This was God’s scheme that was successful. More details can be found in the book titled *Shola-e-Mastoor*.

“الْوَقْبُ” (*al-waqb*): a depression in a mountain or rock in which water has accumulated.

“الْوَقْبَةُ” (*al-waqbah*): a high hole that is a man or two men’s length in smooth ground in which water has accumulated. Thereafter “الْوَقْبُ” (*al-wagb*) was used to mean any hole. It also means to enter something and disappear in it.

“وَقَبَتِ الشَّمْسُ” (*waqabatish shams*): the sun set.

“وَقَبَ الظُّلَامُ” (*waqabaz zalaam*): darkness fell, i.e. people and everything entered in it and disappeared {*T, M, R*}. *Raghib* says it means “to disappear”.

The Quran says:

113:3	when darkness falls all around (when evil lurks in the darkness)	وَمِنْ شَرِّ غَاسِقٍ إِذَا وَقَبَ
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(See heading *Gh-S-Q*).

Maulana Abeedullah Sindhi writes that “غَاسِقٍ إِذَا وَقَبَ” (*ghaasiqin iza waqab*) means “the thing that sets and creates darkness by setting”. It also means anything whose absence halts development, like when the moon goes down. It is harmful for the plants. We seek the protection of God from the ills of life so that He protects us and provides us with better accoutrements of life {*Al-maqaam al-Mahmood*}.

“الْوَقْتُ” (*al-waqt*): the limit of time fixed for some work, therefore this word is not used for indefinite time {*R*}. Indefinite time period cannot be called “الْوَقْتُ” (*al-waqt*). Any deed for which a definite period is fixed is called “مَوْقُتٌ” (*muwaqqat*).

“الْوَقْتُ” (*al-qatuwat*) and “التَّوَقُّتُ” (*at-tauqeet*): to fix the time.

“الْمِيقَاتُ” (*al-meeqaat*): fixed time or place.

“مِيقَاتُ الْحَاجِّ” (*meeqaat-ul-hajj*): the place where the pilgrims put on the particular un-sewn cloth for the pilgrimage of *Hajj* {*T*}.

The Quran says:

77:11	When the time for the messengers shall be fixed	وَإِذَا الرُّسُلُ أَقْبَتَتْ
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Surah *An-Nisa* says “كِتَابًا مَوْقُوتًا” (*kitabau mauquta*) in verse (4:103) about the *salaat*. One meaning of this phrase is particularly “designated duty” and the second meaning is “a duty for which the time has been fixed”.

Ibn Faris says that “الْمَوْقُوتُ” (*al-mauqutu*) means “a thing for which a limit has been set”.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* says about the new moon:

2:189	It is an indicator of the periods for mankind	مَوَاقِيتُ لِلنَّاسِ
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The plural of “مِيقَاتُ” (*meeqaat*) is “مَوَاقِيتُ” (*mawaqeet*). Surah *An-Naba* says that “the time for the results is fixed according to the Law of requital by using words “كَانَا مِيقَاتًا” (*kaana meeqata*) in verse (78:18).

“وَقَدْ” (*waqad*): fire, and for the fire to be bright.

“وَقُودٌ” (*waquud*): the wood which is used to start a fire.

The author of *Lataif-ul-Lugha* has said that “الْحَطَبُ” (*al-hatab*) means “the wood that is used as fuel for the fire” and the wood is called “وَقُودٌ” (*waquud*) when it is lighted for the fire.

“اَوْقَدَ” (*auqad*) and “اِسْتَوْقَدَ” (*istauqad*): to light a fire {T}.

Roohul Ma'aani says it was a custom with the Arabs to light a fire on top of a mountain when a battle was announced. This was called “نار العرب” (*naar-ul-herb*) or the fire of war (5:64).

The Quran says:

2:17	He kindled a fire	اِسْتَوْقَدَ نَارًا
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Surah *Al-Mai'da* says “اَوْقَدَ” (*auqad*) against “اَطْفَأَ” (*atfa*) in verse (5:64), which means “to extinguish the fire”.

Surah *Al-Qasas* while relating the story of the Messenger **Moosa**, the **Pharaoh** said to **Hamaan**:

28:38	O Hamaan, kindle for me (a brick) on clay...	فَاَوْقِدْ لِيْ يٰهَامَنْ عَلَى الطِّيْنِ
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“وَقُودٌ” (*waquud*): fuel (2:25, 66:9, 85:5).

“مَوْقِدَةٌ” (*mooqadatah*): the fire which is alighted (104:6).

“اَلْوَقْدُ” (*al-waqzu*): the force of the blow.

Basa'ir says that “مَوْقُودَةٌ” (*mauquzatu*) means an animal which has been killed by a blow with a stick or with stones, and which is not slaughtered as done now., and that the stones with which the animal has been killed are not sharp {T}. Before the advent of Islam or in the era of ignorance this sort of killed animal used to be eaten.

Ibn Faris says this word basically means “to kill with a blow of the stick”.

“مَوْقُودَةٌ” (*mauquzatah*): an animal which has been killed with a blow of the stick. The Quran says such an animal is forbidden to be eaten (5:3).

Abu Saeed says “اَلْوَقْدُ” (*al-waqzu*) means “to hit behind the neck so hard that it topples the mind” {T}.

The Quran has also declared that “اَلْمَيْتَةُ” (*al-maitatu*), i.e. the animal which is dead as forbidden (for eating). This has been explained by saying that this is not incumbent on the animals which die a natural death only, but it also includes those animals which die of suffocation or who die due to some blow.

“اَلْمَوْقُودَةُ” (*al-mauquzatah*): that which falls from a height and dies, or which dies due to being hurt with the horns of another animal, or which has been hunted by the carnivorous animals. But if the animal is slaughtered according to the Islamic way, then it will not be forbidden (5:3).

“الْوَقْرُ” (*al-waqr*): heaviness in the ears, or loss of hearing {T, M, R}.

The Quran says:

6:25	And there is deafness in their ears	وَفِي أَدْنَاهُمْ وَقْرًا
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“الْوَقْرُ” (*al-wiqru*): heavy burden.

“الْوَقَارُ” (*al-waqaar*): seriousness, greatness.

“جَنَانٌ وَقِيرٌ” (*jananoon waqir*): a courageous heart which is not ruffled {T, M, R}. This too clarifies the meaning of “وَقَارٌ” (*waqaar*).

The Quran says:

71:13	What has gotten over you that you do not ask Allah for seriousness or sobriety?	مَا لَكُمْ لَا تَرْجُونَ لِلَّهِ وَقَارًا
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Here the reference is to the condition in which man is not ruffled by every little thing but a solidity of the sort in which the jolt of death too is unable to ruffle him. But this meaning will be true only when “لِلَّهِ” (*lillah*) is taken to mean “مِنْ اللَّهِ” (*minal laah*), otherwise it will mean “why don’t you believe in the greatness of Allah?”

“وَقَّرَ” (*waqqara*): to respect someone.

“تَعَزَّزُوا وَتَوَقَّروا” (*tu’azziru’hu wa tawaq’qiruhu*): strengthen it and respect it (48:9).

In Surah *Al-Ahzaab* the wives of the Messenger have been told:

33:34	stay within your homes with dignity and seriousness, and do not display any sort of nonsense	وَقَرْنَ فِي بُيُوتِكُنَّ
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This is the meaning if the phrase is taken from “وَقَّرَ” (*waqar*), but *Abu Abeer* says that this is from “وَقَارٌ” (*waqaar*).

“وَقَعَ” (*waqa’a*), “يَقَعُ” (*yaqahu*), “وَقُوعًا” (*wuquaa*): all mean “the thing fell down”.

“وَقَعَتِ الْإِبِلُ” (*waqa’atil iblmeans*): the camels sat down.

“وَقَعَ رَبِيعٌ بِالْأَرْضِ” (*waqa’a rabi’oon fil arz*): the first rain of spring rained down.

“مَوَاقِعُ الْغَيْثِ” (*mawaqi’ool ghais*): the places where it rained.

“وَقَعَتِ الطَّيْرُ” (*waqa’atit tayr*): the birds alighted on the ground after flying in the air.

“الْوَقْعُ” (*al-waqao*): the stones.

“الْوَقِيعَةُ” (*al-waqiyatu*): battle, or an episode.

“وَقَاءُ الْعَرَبِ” (*waqae ul-arab*): the battle days for the Arabs.

“الْوَقِيعَةُ” (*al-waqiyatu*): a hammer {T}.

“الْوَقُوعُ” (*al-waqiyatu*): an event which is distasteful and abhorrent {R}.

Raghib says “الْوَقِيعَةُ” (*al-wuqu’a*) means for something to fall or be proven.

Zajaj says that anything which is sure to happen is called “وَقِيعَةٌ” (*waqiyah*) {T}.

The Quran says:

22:65	Allah (as per law) makes it rain when needed and He rations it so that it may not start raining at its own when it is not needed	وَيُنْسِكُ السَّمَاءَ أَنْ تَقَعَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ
4:100	his compensation became incumbent upon Allah	وَقَعَ أَجْرُهُ عَلَى اللَّهِ

7:118	the truth was proven as it had manifested itself;	وَقَعَ الْحَقُّ
52:7	Verily Allah's punishment must take place	إِنَّ عَذَابَ رَبِّكَ لَوَاقِعٌ
56:1	When the thing which is bound to happen will take place	إِذَا وَقَعَتِ الْوَاقِعَةُ
56:2	There is no lie in its occurrence	لَيْسَ لَوْفَعَتِهَا كَاذِبَةٌ

“مَوَاقِعُ” (*mawaqi'o*): the place where it will happen
 “مُؤَاقِعُ” (*muwaqi'oon*): one who goes and does it (18:53).
 “أَوْقَعَ” (*auqa'a*): to put in (5:61).

W-Q-F وق ف

“وَقُفَّ” (*waqufa*): he kept standing in his place.
 “وَقَفْتُ” (*waqafu*): I made him stay, I furnished lodging for him.

The Quran says “وَقُفُّهُمْ” (*waqifuhum*) in verse (37:24) meaning “make them stay”, or “furnish lodging for them”.

“الْمَوْقِفُ” (*al-mauqifu*): the place where to stand or stay.
 “الْتَوْقِيفُ فِي الْحَدِيثِ” (*at-tauqifu fil hadees*): to make something clear {T, M}.
 “الْتَوْقِيفُ” (*islahaat tauqifu*): to fix some talk.

W-Q-Y وق ي

“وَقَى الشَّيْءَ يَقِيهِ وَقِيًا وَوَقَايَةً” (*waqash shaiyee 'a baqihi aqba aqaaba*): to protect something; to oversee and supervise, to save one from harmful and painful thing.

As such, when a horse walks carefully due to the absence of a horse shoe or due to some injury in his toe or due to pain in his foot or due to the land being hard, then it is called “وَقَى الْفَرَسُ مِنَ الْحَقَا” (*waqal farasu minal hafa*) {T}.

“وَقَايَةً” (*waqayah*): carefulness or a preservative {L}.
 “سَرَجٌ وَاقٍ” (*sarjuw waaq*): a saddle which is just right for the horse's back and it will not injure or hurt him.

The Quran has used the term “وَاقٍ” (*waaq*) to mean “one who saves from harm or protects”.

13:37	There will be none to save or protect you excepting Allah	مَا لَكَ مِنَ اللَّهِ مِنْ وَلِيٍّ وَلَا وَاقٍ
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At another place the matter has appeared to mean “to be careful” and “to protect oneself”, like “فَاتَّقُوا النَّارَ” (*fattaqun naar*) in (2:24) which means “protect yourself from hellfire” or “be careful about it”.

“وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ” (*wattaqul laah*) appears in the Quran time and again and means “observe the laws of Allah” i.e. “to oversee them and obey them and live according to them”. This meaning has been made clear at another place. In Surah *Al-Ma'ida*, “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) has been used against “تَقْوَى” (*taqwa*). Since “عُدْوَانٌ” (*udwaan*) means “rebellion”, thus “تَقْوَى” (*taqwa*) means “the obedience of Allah's laws”.

In Surah *Aal-e-Imran* this has been made clear:

3:101	O, ye who believe, observe the <i>taqwa</i> of Allah as <i>taqwa</i> must be observed	يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ حَقَّ تَقْوَاهُ
3:102	follow Allah's guidance during your entire life	وَلَا تَمُوتُوا إِلَّا وَأَنْتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ
3:103	all together should follow the Quran given by Allah	إِعْتَصِمُوا بِحَبْلِ اللَّهِ جَمِيعًا

These examples make clear that “وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ” (*wat taq-ul-laaha*) means to observe the laws of Allah (the Quran), and to live as per the dictates of the Quran. That is why those who do “تَقْوَى” (*taqwa*) have been declared so against “غَاوِينَ” (*ghaween*) in Surah *Ash-Shura* (96:90-91). “غَاوِينَ” (*ghaween*) are those who leave Allah’s laws and follow their own desires or other laws, hence the *muttaqeen* are those who follow Allah’s laws. Regarding this complete coordination with the laws of Allah, surah *Saad* says “مُنْفِقِينَ” (*munfaqiin*) as against “فُجَّارٍ” (*fujjaar*) (38:28). “فُجَّارٍ” (*fajir*) is something that explodes and separates. See heading (*F-J-R*). Thus *muttaqi* is one who sticks to the Quranic guidance.

With reference to disintegrating and separation and integration, surah *Ash-Shams* says that Allah has put both these traits in human personality:

91:8	If a man wants, he can stick to the code of life given by Allah and thus achieve crystallization of his personality, and if he wants he can move away from it according to his wishes and create confusion and chaos in his personality	فَأَلْهَمَهَا فُجُورَهَا وَتَقْوَاهَا
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About these two groups it is said in Surah *Muhammad* that one group is such which follows its own desires and wishes, but the other group is of those people who follow the revelation. This second group finds its *taqwa* (47:17), but only he can achieve it.

Here “يَتَزَكَّى” (*yatazakka*) means “development of personality” (92:17-18), i.e. whoever donates his surplus wealth for the sustenance of humanity, provides for his own growth and development (2:219).

As such *muttaqeen* are those who avoid the wrong way of life and develop their own personality by following the Quranic values and by avoiding the bad deeds. This is what it means to remain with the permanent values of the Quran i.e. to read, understand, and then accept these values willingly and bring one’s thoughts and deeds in line with the Quranic teaching. This is like “sticking in a way like the saddle fits the horse’s back without hurting him”.

The Quran has stated in the beginning that it is “هُدًى لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ” (*hudal lil muttaqeen*) (2:2), i.e. it guides those who wish to stay away from the wrong path and wish to adopt the righteous path i.e. the path defined by the Quran. Anyone who wants to be destroyed by following his own desires or anyone else’s, can have no interest in the right and wrong of life. The one who is bent upon committing suicide it is useless to advise him about the benefits of living a righteous life.

While studying the Quran, it is important to see the context in which the righteousness (*muttaqeen*) is being referred e.g. whether it is about following the permanent values or to take precautions from the destructive effects of various events.

For example:

“وَقِنَا عَذَابَ النَّارِ” (*waqina azaabun naar*) in (2:601)
“قُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ” (*quwa anfusikum*) in (66:6)
“مَنْ يُوقِ شُحَّ نَفْسِهِ” (*myn yuqa shuha nafsih*) in (59:9)
“وَقِهِمُ السَّيِّئَاتِ” (*waqihimus sayyi’aati*) in (40:9)
“وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ” (*mun taqas sayyiaat*) (59:18).

In all the above verses the meaning is to save or avoid from harm by following the Quran. The term “وَاتَّقُوا” (*wattaqu*) in (59:18) means to avoid the adverse consequences of one’s deeds. This means “save yourself (from the consequences) of breaking the laws of Allah, or avoid rebellious to them. This very thing is called “تَقْوَى” (*taqwa*) and whoever upholds the laws of Allah is the most respectable in Allah’s eyes (49:13) and benefits from the good effects in the long run.

The word *taqwa* is a very comprehensive and frequent term in the Quran and this *taqwa* is so important that it has become a word in its own right, which has been used by the Quran to create more words related to it. It does not mean “abstinence” since “abstinence” is at best a negative virtue, i.e. it is the absence of not doing something which is not good or a sin. But *taqwa* has the connotation of saving oneself from the

pitfalls in life and to observe the laws of Allah all during one's adult life. This means that along with negative virtue, it also has a positive side or deed which is more important and dominant.

As mentioned above, the term *taqwa* is very comprehensive and cannot be explained by one simple sentence. A man with *taqwa* possesses the traits of high moral character and this aspect encompasses both the mind and the physical conduct. The definition of character is very difficult and western scholars too are not united on any one definition, but the Quran has an easy explanation to this human aspect. According to the Quran, there are two levels of a man's life. One is the level of animals whose demands and functions are the same as any animal such as self-preservation, self-assertion, and procreation. The urge of self-preservation is so strong that no individual gives preference to another where this is concerned. The second level is one which may be called "human life". In this life the main purpose is the development of human Self (see N.F.S).

This development can be achieved through upholding the permanent values which have been given to us through the Quran. The Quran acknowledges that the demands and needs of the first or animal level must be carried out but if it so happens that those values come in conflict with the permanent values, then the permanent values should prevail. This is called *taqwa* which is character, not national but individual character. This must be followed and at some stage even if one has to sacrifice one's life to uphold the permanent values then he should do so. The Quran says that those who think that the physical life is everything and they do not believe in the human character are in denial of their own 'Self' (45:24, 47:13, 59:19). To believe in the human Self and to be aware of the inner thought process is the trait of a believer or a *momin*. This is the level at which a *momin* accepts Allah with all His attributes as a model and refers back to the Quranic permanent values to seek guidance in this life. This is what helps him to sign post his character development as noted in (35:10, 14:24)

The Quran also acknowledges that self-interest should generally be kept in mind and that it is only a demand of the intellect to save oneself from loss, and one who knowingly goes into loss is generally thought to be foolish. But for a believer the preservation of the developed Self is more important than any animal level instincts. When the animal instinct and upholding the permanent values clash, one should uphold the thing of greater benefit, that is, "human Self" and sacrifice the thing of little value i.e. "animal instinct". This is why the Quran declares that the Quranic believers are those who are extremely self-conscious, understanding, analytical, rational thinkers, and continuously aware of the permanent values e.g. (3:189), (8:24), (25:63). They continuously refer their thoughts to the Quranic values and evaluate these thoughts and then take decisions – this is important to understand as the decisions taken in line with the Quranic criterion will benefit in the long term i.e. encompassing this life and the life to come (59:18).

Therefore to conclude:

The Quran does not simply make a verbal appeal to man to uphold the permanent values, but it appeals based on reasoning and logic and tells the human intellect how it is good, advantageous, and beneficial for itself to do so. This is the reason that it invites man to believe in one Allah based upon reasoning and logic (12:108). And the basic characteristic of believers is that they do not believe in the Quranic values blindly, i.e. without the use of intellect, reasoning, and logic (25:73). This is what "تَقْوَى" (*taqwa*) according to the Quran is, and those who adopt it are declared "مُتَّقِينَ" (*muttaqeen*).

W-K-A

و ك ا

"تَوَكَّلْ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ" (*tawakkal alash shaiyee*): he took the support of the thing and leaned against it.

"تَوَكَّلْ عَلَى الشَّيْءِ" (*attukaatu*): the stick which is leaned upon while walking, a man who needs a lot of support {*T, M*}.

Surah *Taha* says that the messenger *Moosa* said:

20:12	This is my staff on which I lean and take support of;	هِيَ عَصَايَ أَتَوَكَّلُ عَلَيْهَا
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This figuratively means the laws or commandments (that I have received from Allah) are like a staff for me on which I support myself in order to meet the challenges of this life.

Surah *At-Toor* says:

52:20	Reclining on thrones lined up	مُتَّكِئِينَ عَلَى سُرُرٍ مَّصْفُوفَةٍ
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Surah *Yusuf* says in the context of the dinner thrown by the wife of the Egyptian official:

12:31	And she prepared a banquet for them	وَأَعْتَدَتْ لَهُنَّ مُتَّكًا
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Zajjaj says that “مُتَّكًا” (*muttaka*) in (12:31) means the thing or the pillow, which one leans against during the feast.

Some say it means “food”. As such, it is said “إِتَّكْنَا عِنْدَ زَيْدٍ” (*ittikana inda zaid*) which means “we dined with *Zaid*”.

W-K-D و ك د

“الْوَكَادُ” (*al-wikaad*): the rope with which the cow’s hind legs are tied together while milking it. It also means the strap with which the saddle is secured.

“الْوَاكِيذُ” (*atta wakeed*), “الْأَتَاكِيذُ” (*attakeed*), “الْمَيَاكِيذُ” (*al-myakeed*): the leather straps with which the front or rear parts of a saddle are tied tightly.

“وَكَّدَ الرَّحْلُ” (*wakkadar rakhl*): he tied a seat on a camel tightly.

“وَكَّدَ الْعَهْدُ” (*wakkadal ahda*), “الْعَقْدُ” (*al-akda*), “أَكَّدَ بَهِمَا” (*akkadahuma*): he made the wedding pact very staunch and strong, tied the knot very strongly {*T, M, R and Ibn Faris*}

Khalil says that the word “أَكَّدْتُ” (*akkadt*) is more appropriate for meaning the strength of promises and “وَكَّدْتُ” (*wakkattu*) for the strength of said statement {*R*}. Some have said that “تَوَكَّيْتُ” (*taukeed*) as compared to “تَأَكَّدْتُ” (*ta’keed*) is more comprehensive (8:91) {*T*}. The Quran says “do not break your promises after committing to them”.

W-K-Z و ك ز

“الْوَكْزُ” (*al-wakz*): to push, to hit with a fist, to deliver a blow, to hit the chin with a fist.

“وَكَّزَهُ بِالرُّمْحِ” (*wakazahu bir rumh*): he put the lance into him.

“وَكَّزْتُ أَنْفَهُ” (*wa kaztu anfahu*): I broke his nose {*T, M, R*}.

Surah *Al-Qasas* says:

28:15	<i>Moosa</i> hit him with a fist.	فَوَكَّزَهُ مُوسَىٰ
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W-K-L و ك ل

“رَجُلٌ وَكَلٌ” (*rajulun wakulun*), “مُوَكَالٌ” (*muwakil*): a man who himself is weak and looks for support from other people in doing every work.

“تَوَاكَلُوا” (*tawakulu*), “تَوَاكَلَا” (*tawakala*): people started delegating each other’s work to one another.

“إِتَّكَلَ عَلَيْهِ فِي أَمْرِهِ” (*ittakal alaihi fee amrihi*): he trusted him in his affair.

“أَوَكَّلْتُ عَلَى أَخِيكَ الْعَمَلَ” (*au kaltu ala akhikal amal*): I left everything completely to your brother.

“الْوَكِيلُ” (*al-wakeel*): supervisor or one who looks after the affairs of another {*T*}. It also means “one responsible for something” {*T*}.

We are used to “تَوَكَّلْ عَلَى اللَّهِ” (*tawakkul al allaah*) meaning delegating all work to Allah and not doing anything on your own. This meaning of “تَوَكَّلْ” (*tawakkul*) is against the Quranic meaning because at every step the Quran advocates continuous struggle with strong resolve and *Iman* in the permanent values.

If you throw a man into the sea he will drown if he cannot swim. If you throw a piece of iron into the water it will sink immediately, but if you build a ship out of iron sheets according to a particular design then the contraption will float on the water, and it will also carry many people.

We sail ships on the sea with equanimity and also board such ships with complete equanimity. Where does this equanimity come from? The equanimity is born of the belief that the ship will not sink because it has been built according to the laws of Allah in which a ship built to a certain size and design will not sink. These laws can be fully relied upon, and they will not deceive us if followed honestly. This hope will not diminish or disappear. This support will not give way. This is what “تَوَكَّلْ” (*tawakkal*) is.

The Quran says that in the same way that Allah’s laws about things in the universe can be relied upon, and they shall never deceive us, so do social laws of Allah given to us through the Quran can be relied upon, and they will never deceive us. If human beings follow those social laws then good results will definitely come out of them. This is called “تَوَكَّلْ عَلَى اللَّهِ” (*tawakkal al-allah*) and in these meanings Allah is “الْوَكِيلُ” (*al-wakeel*) or one whose laws can be fully depended upon. (*azm*) or the solid intent of doing something is a necessary condition of this “تَوَكَّلْ” (*tawakkal*) (3:158). The group of believers is one which has full belief with intent on the laws of Allah. Such people are called “مُتَوَكِّلِينَ” (*mutawakkileen*) as in (3:158). Anyone who believes in any other law is a *mushrik* (one who attributes other laws to Allah’s laws) and cannot benefit in the long term (16:99,100)

“وَكَّلَ” (*wakkala*): to delegate the matter to someone (6:90).

Surah *As-Sajdah* says:

32:11	to whom you have been assigned	وَكَّلَ بِكُمْ
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W-L-T و ل ت

“الْوَلْتُ” (*al-walt*): to minimize the loss.

“وَلَّاتَهُ” (*walatah*), “حَقَّقَهُ” (*haqqah*), “يَلِّتُهُ” (*yalituh*), “أَوَّلَّاتَهُ” (*awlatah*): all mean “he lessened his right” {T, M}.

The Quran says:

52:21	We shall not depreciate their deeds	مَا أَتَيْنَاهُمْ مِنْ عَمَلِهِمْ
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This has also been written under the heading (*L-Y-T*), (*W-L-J*).

W-J-L و ل ج

“وَلَجَ” (*walja*), “يَلِجُ” (*yalju*): to enter {T, M}.

Raghib says “الْوُلُوجُ” (*al-wuluj*) means “to enter a narrow space”.

Some think it means “to enter slowly” {T, M}.

“الْوَالِيجَةُ” (*al-waleejah*): bosom friend, sincere friend, a man who is not your kith or kin, but who is very reliable to you (who is in a way insider to your clan), confidante (9:16).

Surah *As-Saba* states “وَلَجَ” (*walaja*) against “خَرَجَ” (*kharaja*) in (34:2).

At another place it is stated:

31:29	He makes the day enter night and night enter day.	يُؤَلِّجُ اللَّيْلَ فِي النَّهَارِ وَيُؤَلِّجُ النَّهَارَ فِي اللَّيْلِ
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“الْوَلَدُ” (*al-walad*): whom somebody has given birth to. It is used for singular, plural, masculine and feminine.

The plural is “أَوْلَادٌ” (*aulaad*), “وَلَدَةٌ” (*wildah*) and “وَلَدٌ” (*waldun*) {T}.

But it is also used to mean for a “foetus in the womb” {M}.

“الْوَلِيدُ” (*al-waleed*): a child, till it remains a young. It also means “slave” or “servant”.

“وَلَدَانٌ” (*wildaan*): the plural of “الْوَلَدُ” (*al-walad*).

“أَلْوَالِدُ” (*al-waalid*): father.

“أَلْوَالِدَةُ” (*al-waalidah*): mother.

“أَلْوَالِدَانِ” (*al-wildaan*): mother and father, parents.

“مَوْلِدٌ” (*mauluud*): the time and place of birth.

“مِيلَادٌ” (*milaad*): the time of birth {T}.

Muheet says that “الْتَوْلُدُ” (*at-tawallud*) means “some organic thing to be produced without parents in the heat of summer”, like organisms are born in water {M}. This is probably a term of that time because we have later found out that even germs are not born without “parents”, although the process of their birth is rather different to that of “تَوْلِيدٌ” (*tauleed*).

At several places in the Quran it has been said that God has no “وَلَدٌ” (*wald*) or father (4:171). This does not only contradict what the Christians believe that Jesus is the son of God, it is also meant by this that God has not created the universe through the process of “تَوْلِيدٌ” (*tauleed*), (or from a mother and father), but was created (parentless) by God. In pro-creation or “تَوْلِيدٌ” (*tauleed*), that which is born contains a part of the pro-creator (genes), and that part is reduced in the pro-creator, but in the process of creation, no portion of the creator is passed on to the creation. Therefore, “creation” does not produce any deficiency in the creator.

God is the Creator and He wants man to be creative too. As far as birth is concerned, it is a biological process which both animals and humans share. Man attains the level of humanity when he is creative but procreation only gives it an animal level (although for reproduction this too is necessary). Man should see as to how much “creation” he has made, not how much he has pro-created, how many kids he has produced. Creation is a duty for the human beings. This is the reason that the Quran accepts that beside Allah, there are other creators. It calls Allah as “أَحْسَنُ الْخَالِقِينَ” (*ahsanul khaaliqueen*) or the “best of creators”, i.e. “He, whose creation is the best” (23:14).

The *Lataif-ul-Lugha* says that “وَلَدٌ” (*al-wald*) means “the son” as well as “his son”, i.e. “grandson”, but “الْمَوْلُودُ” (*al-mauluud*) only means “the true son” (who is direct).

While giving the orders about inheritance, the Quran says:

4:11	Allah instruct you this in regards to your children	يُوصِيكُمُ اللَّهُ فِي أَوْلَادِكُمْ
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“أَوْلَادٌ” (*aulaad*) is the plural of “وَلَدٌ” (*walad*) and therefore not only means “sons and daughters” but also their sons and daughters. If some deceased’s son is alive then he will be the deceased’s “وَلَدٌ” (*walad*). But if a man has died, and his son is alive (that is, the grandson) then he will be the “وَلَدٌ” (*walad*) of the deceased son and he will inherit from the grandfather’s inheritance. Similarly a man’s children will also inherit, or will be included among the “أَوْلَادٌ” (*aulaad*). Similarly only the living parents will not inherit but the grand-parents too.

Surah *Al-Baqrah* has stated that mothers should suckle their children for two years:

2:233	And the responsibility of their provision is on their father	وَعَلَى الْمَوْلُودِ لَهُ رِزْقُهُنَّ
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The responsibility or of the upkeep of the mother and the child is on the father. The Quran has used the words “مَوْلُودٌ لَهُ” (*mauludun lahu*) i.e. “he for whom the woman has given birth to the child”, thus if the father is present then these words will apply to him. If he is not present then these words will apply to whoever (male) takes his place.

W-L-Y

و ل ی

“الْوَلِيُّ” (*al-walyu*): to get closer to someone. *Ibn Faris* too says this is the meaning of the word.

“دَارٌ وَلِيَّةٌ” (*daarun waliyyah*): house nearby {T}.

“الْأُولَى” (*al-walyu*): for the next thing to be adjacent to the first thing without any border or barrier in between {T}.

Raghib says that “الْوَلَاءُ” (*al-wal'u*) and “الْأَوَالِي” (*at tauli*) means for two things to appear one after the other in such a way that nothing comes in between them, which is dis-similar to them.

“وَلَيْتَ الْأَرْضُ” (*waliyatil ard*): the land had the first rainfall of spring.

“أُولَى لَكَ فَأُولَى” (*aula laka fa aula*): destruction is imminent. This way this metaphor is used to mean “near” {R}.

Ibn Faris too says this is a warning, and is said when an opportunity has been missed (gone out of hand).

“هُوَ أَوْلَى بِكَذَا” (*huwa aula bikaza*): he is more deserving or capable (33:6).

“الْوَلِيُّ” (*al-waliyyu*): friend and helper.

“الْمُؤَالَاةُ” (*al-muwalah*): to love each other and be friendly, to have an agreement, to be near one another, to appear continuously. It also means to intervene for establishing peace between two quarrelling individuals.

“إِسْتَوْلَى عَلَى الشَّيْءِ” (*istaula alash shaiyi*): to take over something by force.

“إِسْتَوْلَى عَلَى الْأَمْرِ” (*istaula ilal amr*): to be dominant in some matter {T}.

“الْوِلَايَةُ” (*al-wilaayatu*): statehood {M}.

“وَالٍ” (*waalin*): administrator or ruler.

“أَوَّلَيْتُهُ الْأَمْرَ” (*aulaituhul amr*): I made him administrator in the thing or matter.

“الْوَلِيُّ” (*al-waliyyu*): ruler and administrator {T}.

“تَوَلَّاهُ” (*tawallahu*): made him the *wali* (16:100).

“تَوَلَّى الْأَمْرَ” (*tawal lal amr*): he accepted the responsibility in the matter.

“وَلَّى” (*walla*) has differing meanings, as “to refer to someone” and also “to avoid someone”.

“وَلَّى بِأَرَبًا” (*walla haariban*): turned away and ran.

“قَوْلٌ وَجْهَكَ شَطْرَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ” (*fawalli wajhaka shataril masjidil haraam*): face towards the sacred mosque in *Mecca*.

“تَوَلَّاهُ” (*tawalla unhu*): avoided him, neglected him {T}.

“تَوَلَّاهُ” (*tawallahu*): to follow it and to adopt it (16:100).

The Quran uses this root in the following opposite meanings:

- To face someone (2:115) and to turn the face away (2:142) and to become the ruler (2:205)
- Overwhelm and overpower (18:45), and helper or supporter (7:111)
- Heir (19:5, 17:33), a distant relative (4:33, 10:5).

One way is to bow willingly before an ideology or belief and make this the purpose of one's life, which is called “إِيمَانٌ” (*imaan*), and then follow it fully, this is called Islam. But the other path is to find ways and excuses to get around the first way. This is circumvention or avoidance. This is called “تَوَلَّى” (*tawall*). As such in (2:137), this word has been used opposite to “إِيمَانٌ” (*imaan*), and in (3:19) opposite to “أَسْلَمَ” (*aslama*). Also see (16:81-82), (4:80).

This word is used against “إِطَاعَةٌ” (*ita'at*) which means “obedience”, thus “تَوَلَّى” (*tawall*) not only means “to defect to another way of life” but also “to follow it partly and find ways to avoid it while remaining

within a religion or a system". That is why "تَوَلَّى" (*tawalla*) has been used against "صَلَّى" (*salla*) in (75:31, 32). "صَلَّى" (*salla*) means "to follow completely or obey completely, to follow in somebody's footsteps". In opposition to "صَلَّى" (*salla*), "تَوَلَّى" (*tawalla*) means to shun the **Deen** (way of life) prescribed by the Quran and in its place "to consider self-created practices as the way of life, and to consider this as the observance of the (real) **Deen**".

Ordinarily the Quran has described the relationship between man and Allah as friendly. If man follows the laws of Allah then Allah becomes a friend and **wali**, and the enlivening results accompany man. As a consequence through man's following these laws, Allah's universal program gets implemented (i.e. the universe becomes a better place). Thus man too becomes the "**wali** of Allah". Therefore on one hand the Quran calls Allah the **wali** of man (2:257), and on the other hand has called the **momineen** as "أَوْلِيَاءَ" (*auliya*) of Allah, meaning "friends of Allah" (10:62).

"أَوْلِيَاءَ" (*auliyah*) is the plural form of "وَلِيٌّ" (*waliyyun*). Remember that there is no particular group of the *auliya* of Allah. According to the Quran every **momin** is an *aulia* of Allah. It has been clearly stated as *aulia* of Allah:

10:63	Those who have faith in the Quran and live according to its laws	الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَكَانُوا يَتَّقُونَ
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Their characteristic, it says:

10:64	They enjoy the pleasantness of life here (in this world) as well as in the life hereafter	هُمْ أَهْلُ الْبُشْرَىٰ فِي الْحَيَاةِ الدُّنْيَا وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ
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Nobody can obviously see the life hereafter, but the life in this world can indeed be witnessed. Therefore *auliya* of Allah are those who enjoy life in this world and make efforts to establish Deen in this world because it is through this system that successes in this world as well as in the hereafter can be achieved. This group of people has been called the "حِزْبُ اللَّهِ" (*hizbullah*) or "the party of Allah" (58:22). Those who remove themselves from them or oppose them are those who live in rebellion to this system, and are hence "حِزْبُ الشَّيْطَانِ" (*hizbush shaitaan*) (58:19) i.e. those who follow their own desires. Any other concept of *aulia* of Allah other than this is non-Quranic and is borrowed from others.

In Surah **Muhammed** it has been stated that if the conditions of former nations are considered, then one can find out what happened to those who went against the permanent values. Those who are rebellious even now will share the fate of those rebellious nations. After that it is said:

47:11	This is because those who believe in what the revelation has brought them, have Allah as their maula (friend, companion, benefactor), and those who oppose this way, do not have any maula	ذَٰلِكَ بِأَنَّ اللَّهَ مَوْلَى الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَأَنَّ الْكَافِرِينَ لَا مَوْلَى لَهُمْ
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This means that the nations which oppose the permanent values of the Quran cannot be saved by anyone from the destructive results of their deeds. Thus nobody can be their **maula**.

"أَنْتَ مَوْلَانَا" (*anta maulana*): you are our **malula** (2:286).

But Surah **At-Tahreem** says:

66:4	His maula is Allah and Jibreel and Saleh momineen	فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ مَوْلَى وَجِبْرِيلُ وَصَالِحُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ
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Obviously the way in which Allah can be the **maulah** (friend) of somebody, none other can. Therefore the friendships of Allah, **Jibreel** and the **momineen** are obviously of different types. To consider them to be **maula** in the same way is wrong. Nobody's friendship can provide any help against the laws of Allah.

44:41	The day when no friend can help any friend	يَوْمَ لَا يُعْنِي مَوْلَى عَنْ مَوْلَى شَيْئًا
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The Quran has reiterated the fact repeatedly that **momineen** can be each other's **wali** but a **momin** cannot be the **wali** of a non-**momin**. It is obvious that only those people can befriend each other who share the same purpose in life. Those who have different purposes in life will obviously have different paths to

achieve them, so how can they be each other's companions and confidantes? Non-*momins* can be co-operated within good things, but they cannot be made one's confidantes. In this context see verse (3:27), (3:117), (4:89), (4:139), (4:144), (5:51-55), (8:73), (9:10, 23, 37), (47:12,13), (58:22) and (60:104).

W-N-Y

و ن ی

“الْوَنَى” (*al-wana*): tiredness, exhaustion.

“وَنَى” (*wana*), “يَنَى” (*yani*), “وَنِيَا” (*wanya*): to be idle, to weaken, to be weak and old.

“نَاقَةً” (*naaqatu*), “وَانِيَةً” (*waaniya*): tired camel.

Ibn Faris says that this word basically means “weakness and senility”.

“الْمِينَا” (*al-meena*) and “الْمِينَاءُ” (*al-meena*): port, place where ships rest after arriving.

“الْمِينَا” (*al-meena*): the pieces of stone which are used to make ceramics {*T*}.

Surah *Taha* calls upon *Moosa* and *Haroon* to go to the Pharaoh:

20:42	And never slacken in the struggle to further the code cause of Allah. (Your struggle should not slacken a bit for this purpose.)	وَلَا تَبَيَّأْ فِي ذِكْرِي
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W-He-B

و ه ب

“وَهَبَ” (*wahaba*), “يَهَبُ” (*yahabu*), “وَهْبًا” (*wahba*), “هَبَّةً” (*hibah*): to endow, to give.

“الْهَبَّةُ” (*al-hibah*): the gift which is not given as compensation nor involves any interest of the giver.

“الْمَوْهَبَةُ” (*al-mauhibah*): a cloud which rains down over the place where it hovers.

“أَوْهَبْتُ لِأَمْرٍ كَذَا” (*au habtu li amri kaza*): I dominated the matter (or *amr*) {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

33:50	If he surrenders himself to the messenger	إِنْ وَهَبْتَ نَفْسَهَا
19:19	He said that I have brought you a message from your Sustainer, which is that “I will endow you with a chaste and developed child”.	قَالَ إِنَّمَا أَنَا رَسُولُ رَبِّكِ لِأَهَبَ لَكِ غُلَامًا زَكِيًّا
26:21	Allah has granted me (<i>Moosa</i>) the messenger-hood. (Messenger-hood cannot be acquired through any personal effort)	فَوَهَبَ لِي رَبِّي حُكْمًا

Allah has the trait of being “الْوَهَّابُ” (*al-wahhab*) as mentioned in (3:7). Here it means that Allah bestows abundantly without expecting anything in return.

Surah *Saad* has used this word to mean “return”:

38:43	to endow for those who are lost	وَوَهَبْنَا لَهُ أَهْلَهُ
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To be found again is a sort of gift too.

“وَجَّتِ النَّارُ” (*wahajatin naar*), “وَجَّأَ” (*wahja*): for the fire to be alight and burn bright.
 “الْوَجَّجُ” (*al-wahaj*): the sun and the heat of fire.
 “تَوَجَّجَ الْجَوْهَرُ” (*tawah-hajal jauhar*): the jewel shone brightly {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

78:13	We created the sun as a lamp which gives out light and heat abundantly.	وَجَعَلْنَا سِرَاجًا وَهَّاجًا
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Lais says that “الْوَهْنُ” (*waahin*) means “for a man to be feeble in some matter or work”.

“وَاهِنٌ” (*al-wahn*): to be found weak in some matter or weak in body.
 “مَوْهُونٌ” (*mauhun*): a man who is bodily weak {*T*}.

Surah *Ale-e-Imran* uses “وَهْنٌ” (*wahn*) along with the words to mean “weak and feeble” (3:145). This expostulates the meaning of this word.

“وَهِنَ” (*wahna*): became weak and feeble.
 “وَاهَانَا” (*wahana*): made weak.

Surah *Al-Anfaal* says:

8:18	Allah will weaken or foil the plans of the opponents	إِنَّ اللَّهَ مُؤَيِّنُ كَيْدِ الْكَافِرِينَ
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The *muslims* have been told:

3:138	You shall have no weakness, neither physical nor of knowledge, intellect or insight	وَلَا تَهِنُوا
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This is said so because the Quran has considered it necessary to have both sorts of strengths, physical as well as mental (2:247), nor any weakness in character.

This shall result in:

3:138	you will rise above all (if you follow the Quran)	أَنْتُمْ الْأَعْلَوْنَ
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“الْوَهْيُ” (*al-wahyu*): for a gap to appear in anything, for the fasteners of anything to loosen.
 “وَاهَا” (*awhah*): he made him weak, he weakened him.
 “الْحَايَةُ يَاهِي” (*al-haaitu yahi*): the wall is about to fall {*T, R*}.
 “رَجُلٌ وَاهٍ” (*rajulun wah*): feeble, infirm, weak or unreliable.
 “حَدِيثٌ وَاهٍ” (*hadeesun wah*): very weak matter {*T, R*}.

The Quran says:

69:16	The sky will be torn asunder and its fastenings will become loose.	وَأَنْشَقَّتِ السَّمَاءُ فَهِيَ يَوْمَئِذٍ وَاهِيَةٌ
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“وَى” (*wy*): this word is used to express wonder or sorrow.

The Quran says:

28:82	Alas! Oh, we thought it was like this, but it so appears that the matter was opposite to it...	وَى كَانَ
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“وَيْلٌ” (*wayl*): for evil to take place.

This word is a static noun and has no verb *{T}*. This word is used to express pain and sadness, or punishment and misery, or a bad result.

“الْوَيْلُ” (*al-weila*): ignominy, destruction and annihilation *{T}*.

“وَيْلٌ” (*wayl*): destruction (104:1).

“وَيْلَكَ” (*weilaka*): repentance (46:17)

“يَوَيْلَتِي” (*ya-wailati*): mixed emotions of shame and surprise (taken a back) (11:72).

When this letter comes at the end of a word, it associates the words property factor.

It is used for both masculine and feminine.

“غُلَامِي” (*ghulami*): my slave.

“نَعْمَتِي الْيَّتَى” (*nemati yallati*): My favour which I ... (2:40).

Sometimes it is removed or only implied like in “وَلِي دِينٍ” (*wali-ya deen*). Here “ى” (*ya*) after “دِينٍ” (*deen*) has been removed and only “دِينٍ” (*deen*) is remained.

It is a word for addressing in the meaning of “O’ you”.

“يَا أَرْضُ ابْلَعِي” (*ya ardubla’i*): O’ Earth, swallow it.

Sometimes it is only implied:

“رَبِّ لَا تَذَرْنِي فَرْدًا” (*rabbi la tazarni farad*): (21:89) (O my Sustainer, do not let me be alone.

Here the word before Sustainer is only implied, not actually written.

After “يَا” (*ya*), the word “أَيُّهَا” (*ayyuhul*) is added:

“يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا” (*ya ayyuhul lazeena aamau*): O’ you, who believe (9:28).

“الْيَاسُ” (*alyaas*): to despair and lose hope.

“يُؤْسُ” (*yaw’os*), “يُؤْسُ” (*ya’oos*): someone who loses hope.

“إِسْتَيْسَ” (*istayaas*): lost hope {T}.

Surah *Yusuf* says:

12:80	when they lost all hope in him	فَلَمَّا اسْتَيْسُوا مِنْهُ
12:87	do not despair of Allah’s mercy (nobody but the unbelievers do so)	وَلَا تَيْسُوا مِنْ رُوحِ اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ لَا يَأْتِيَنَّ
13:31	do they not come to know about it	أَفَلَمْ يَأْتِيَنَّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا

Ibn Faris says that among the basic meanings we have “to know” or “to comprehend”.

Raghib says that this is a figurative meaning.

Surah *Al-Mumtahina* says:

60:13	the denial which is born of hopelessness	قَدْ يَسُّوا مِنَ الْآخِرَةِ
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Consider the above verse of Surah *Yusuf* once more. You will find a great principle about the rise and fall of nations in it. This verse says:

12:87	do not despair of Allah’s benevolence because nobody despairs of God’s mercy (<i>rehmat</i>) except those who do not believe	وَلَا تَيْسُوا مِنْ رُوحِ اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ لَا يَأْتِيَنَّ مِنْ رُوحِ اللَّهِ إِلَّا الْفُؤُومُ الْكَافِرُونَ
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At another place this has been said as:

39:53	Despair not of the mercy of Allah	لَا تَقْنَطُوا مِنْ رَحْمَةِ اللَّهِ
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A **momin** believes in the laws of Allah, i.e the result of righteous deeds and their veracity, and he traverses the righteous path with the belief that if due to some difficulty or due to some error on his part he may come to suffer a loss, this does not shake his belief and he never loses hope. He staggers but recovers, rectifies the wrong he has committed and once more starts following the right path. This is what is meant by not losing hope in Allah's mercy i.e. referring all thoughts back to the Quran for guidance. One who loses hope is one who is following a path that is based on conjecture and speculation. When he meets failure then he stops right there and loses hope of ever reaching his destination, but he who believes in the path being correct which is determined in the light of the Quran never loses hope. This is the reason that the Quran says hopelessness and devilishness (*Ibleesiyat*) are akin. See heading (**B-L-S**). But Allah's mercy is not invoked by sitting around and doing nothing.

It has been said:

7:56	in order to be free of misery and to invoke benefit, call upon the laws of Allah and have faith that Allah's mercy is near those who live a balanced life	إِنَّ رَحْمَتَ اللَّهِ قَرِيبٌ مِنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ
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Another important issue needs our attention here. A man is engulfed in misery and he finds no way out, but he does not lose hope. He is not disappointed. He takes it as an inevitability of the events. He does not let hopelessness set in him. This man does not despair of Allah's mercy and kindness. But if he decides when facing some setback that he is not able to face the challenge then despondence sets in. Anyone who has faith, and who is confident never lets despondence set in i.w. he has confidence and is therefore hopeful. But a man who loses faith in himself and lets despondence set in, becomes a victim of depression. He becomes frustrated and this might even in some cases lead to committing suicide. He who commits suicide considers himself valueless. He thinks there is no cause any more for him to remain alive. He falls from grace in his own eyes. Since all depends on materialistic means in a materialistic concept of life, therefore when those means come to an end for some reason, then one becomes despondent. However, the possibilities of human endurance and inner Self are infinite and none should say at any time, that I can do no more. He can acknowledge that he is out of materialistic means, but he should never lose faith in his Self.

“كفر” (*kufir*) is actually a denial of one's Self and also denial of another Truth i.e. the denial of the infinitely developed Self of Allah as a model. Besides, by having hope in the human Self, one learns to feel the need for the permanent values which one gets through the revelation – these values prevent him from avoiding the tribulations in life and facing these trials and tribulations do not let him be despondent. He is not even afraid to face the physical death because he knows that death is only a taste for his Self (29:57) and he gradually develops the assurance based on evidence that his Self will survive to the next life. Note that why despondence or hopelessness is actually “كفر” (*kufir*) and how the Quran helps to replace it with *Iman* in Allah and turns it into hope and leads to real happiness.

Yajooj/Majooj يَاجُوجُ/مَاجُوجُ

The nation on behalf of whose protection from attacks *Zulqarnain* had built a wall (18:94). Details can be found under the heading (**A-J-J**).

Yaqoot يَاقُوتٌ

“يَاقُوتٌ” (*al-yaqoot*) is a Persian word which is also used in Arabic. It is used for a hard and clear stones of different colours, usually red.

The Quran says:

55:58	As if they are <i>yaqoot</i> and <i>marjaan</i>	كَأَنَّهُنَّ الْيَاقُوتُ وَالْمَرْجَانُ
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Y a laita يَلَيْتُ

It is the compound of “يا” (*ya*) and “لَيْتُ” (*lait*) which means “only if”. See heading “يا” (*ya*) and “لَيْتُ” (*lait*).

Y-B-S ي ب س

“يَبِسَ” (*yabisa*): for something which is damp, to dry up.

“الْيَبْسُ” (*al-yabsu*): a thing which is wet and then it dries up.

“شَاةٌ يَبَسُ” (*shah to-yabas*): a goat whose teats dry up and it stops giving milk {T}. “الْيَابِسَاتُ” (*al-yaabisaatu*): a place which has water and then it dries up {M}. In Torah the word (*al-yabsu*) has been used for the dry land.

The Quran says that *Moosa* was directed:

20:77	Lead the <i>Bani Israel</i> by the way which was under water previously but which is now dry	فَاضْرِبْ لَهُمْ طَرِيقًا فِي الْبَحْرِ يَبَسًا
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Surah *Al-Anaam* says:

6:59	there is no wet or dry thing (wet or dry fruit) in the universe which does not have the necessary laws in the book of nature	وَلَا رَطْبٌ وَلَا يَابِسٌ إِلَّا فِي كِتَابٍ مُبِينٍ
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Y-T-M ي ت م

“الْيَتِيمُ” (*al-yutm*): to become lonely and alone i.e. by oneself. This is its basic meaning.

Usma'i says that “الْيَتِيمُ” (*al-yateem*) means sandy land which is different from the surrounding lands.

Ibnul Airaabi says that “الْمَيْتَمُ” (*al-maitam*) is said for anything which is lonely and by itself.

Raghib thinks that any unique and lonely thing is “يَتِيمٌ” (*yateem*) {T, R, M}

“دُرَّةٌ يَتِيمَةٌ” (*durratun yateemah*): a unique pearl which is one of its kind:

An orphan is also called “يَتِيمٌ” (*yateem*) because he is left alone.

Haraali says that for the father not to be present when he is needed is called “يَتِيمٌ” (*yutm*). This is why until the child attains maturity he is called “يَتِيمٌ” (*yateem*), but after maturity he is no more called so. As against this, a girl is called “يَتِيمَةٌ” (*yateemah*) until she is wedded even though she may be adult. Among animals a young one is called “يَتِيمٌ” (*yateem*) if he loses his mother, because in animals it is the mother which nurtures the young. They do not really need the father after birth. If a human child's mother dies, then the child is not called “يَتِيمٌ” (*yateem*). It is called “مُنْقَطِعٌ” (*munqati'un*) or “عَجِيٌّ” (*ajji'yun*). If it loses both mother and father then it is called “لَيْتَمٌ” (*lateem*). The plural is “أَيْتَامٌ” (*aitaam*) as well as “يَتَامَى” (*yataama*).

“إِمْرَأَةٌ مُؤْتِمٌ” (*imra'atun mu'tim*): a woman whose children become orphans, i.e. whose husband dies {T, R, M}.

Lissanul Arb says that “يَتِيمٌ” (*yateem*) means a woman who has no husband, i.e. he has either died or was not there in the first place. The Quran says “يَتِمَى النِّسَاءُ” (*yataman nisaa'i*) in (4:127) and refers to such lonely women.

Keep these meanings of “يَتِيمٌ” (*yatama*) in mind and then recall Surah *An-Nisa*’s verse which says:

4:3	If you find that you will not be able to do “justice” with the <i>yutama</i> (will not be able to fulfill their rights), you can wed either two, or three, or four of them	وَإِنْ خِفْتُمْ أَلَّا تُقْسِطُوا فِي الْيَتَامَىٰ فَانكِحُوا مَا طَابَ لَكُمْ مِنَ النِّسَاءِ مَثَلًا وَثَلَاثَ وَرُبْعَ
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After the advent of Islam the small group of *muslims* had to fight many battles in which many women became (imprisoned and were turned slave-girls (as was the practice). Many adult girls could not find husbands. This was a problem which needed to be solved quickly.

The difficulty was due to:

- the ordinary order of the Quran is to wed one woman (4:3)
- the *muslim* women were not permitted to marry the *kaafir* (the unbelievers) or the *mushriks* (those who also followed other laws). They had to wed *muslim* men only and their numbers were greatly reduced as stated earlier.

To overcome this emergent problem the Quran had temporarily relaxed the rule for monogamy and said that these women who were left without husbands or had become widows or were unmarried can due to these exceptional circumstances, marry as advised in (4:3). Subject to one’s choice, these women were provided the protection (of a man or husband). This is the only verse in the Quran where polygamy or more than one marriage has been allowed. If such conditions do not prevail then the law of a single marriage i.e. one man to one man will prevail.

“يَتِيمٌ” (*yatim*), “يَتِيمًا” (*yatma*): to weaken or become feeble, to become unable or become tired, also to become an outcast.

“يَتِيمٌ” (*yatm*): sadness and worry and also to delay or neglect, because delay is made often in helping the orphans or they are neglected.

“الْيَتِيمُ” (*al-yatam*): need or requirement {T, R, M}.

The Quran exhorts looking after the orphans and describes the reason for the destruction caused by the capitalist system.

89:17	You do not honour the <i>yateem</i>	لَا تُكْرِمُونَ الْيَتِيمَ
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Here “يَتِيمٌ” (*yateem*) does not only mean, those whose fathers are dead, it also means all those people who have been left helpless in a society. It means anyone who feels that he is alone in a society (can be physical or mental or both isolations) and nobody is there to help him and his misery is entirely his own (and not shared by anyone). Hence it means someone who feels that there is nobody to commiserate with him or help him. A society that does not respect such a person gets eventually destroyed. The Quran creates a society (& a world) in which nobody feels that he is left alone, and that there is nobody to help him.

That is why Allah has told the Messenger *Muhammed*:

93:6	Is not it a fact that he found you to be <i>yateem</i> and provided the means for your upkeep	أَلَمْ يَجِدْكَ يَتِيمًا فَآوَىٰ
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This makes it clear that a “يَتِيمٌ” (*yateem*) is someone who is without sanctuary, and to provide shelter or sanctuary for such a person is the responsibility of the society that is established in the name of Allah based on the Quranic values.

“يحيى” (*Yahya*) has been said to be among the messengers of the *Bani Israel* by the Quran (6:85). He was the son of *Zakariyah* (9:7), a messenger with a book and a firm and a decisive man since childhood (19:12), and man of many righteous traits (19:13-15). Some think that *John*, as mentioned by the Bible, is the same person as *Yahya*. The Bible in respect of “*John*” says that “I tell you that verily nobody greater than *John* has been born who baptizes”.

Renan in his book, *Life of Jesus*, writes that the centre for *John's* education was *Judea* but he was famous far and wide and *Jesus* had also visited him. He further writes, that *John* and *Jesus* established a strange but revolutionary system in the desert until in the year 29, *John* was arrested after which *Jesus* had returned to his homeland.

Y-D-Y

ي د ي

“الْيَدُ” (*al-yad*): hand (feminine). The plural is “الْأَيْدِي” (*aydin*), but this word is used to mean so many things that it is not possible or relevant to mention all of them here. It is used as we use the word “hand” in *Urdu*, like place and honour, protection, expertise, power and authority, dominance and over-powering, helper, help and reply to call for help, a reward or favour.

This word also means “shame and chagrin insult”.

The Quran says about the Messengers:

38:45	They possessed both strength and insight	أُولَى الْأَيْدِي وَالْأَبْصَارِ
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On the other hand, about their opponents it is said that they always tried to:

14:9	prevent them from speaking	فَرَدُّوا أَيْدِيَهُمْ فِي أَفْوَاهِهِمْ
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Ibn Qateebah has said it also means that in their anger or frustration, they begin to wring or cut their own hands {R}.

This word will be translated according to the context in the Quran wherever it appears. The Quran uses the phrase “بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ” (*baina yadaihi*) at several places which literally means “between his both hands”, i.e. “in front”.

The Quran has called itself “مُصَدِّقًا لِّمَا بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ” (*musaddiqal lima baina yadaih*). As such, “لِّمَا بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ” (*lima baina yadaih*) means that which is in front of it. The Quran calls itself the supporter of the moral values which had been sent before its advent and some of these were present in the society even at the time of the advent of the Quran, such as “do not lie” and “do not steal” etc. The Quran supported such values. It did not support the entire earlier books existing at the time because it considers these books as “tampered with”. For the right meaning of “مصدق” (*musaddiq*), see heading (*Sd-D-Q*).

The Quran has used this term, some of these are noted below:

51:47	We have created the heavens (the planets or space) with power and authority	وَالسَّمَاءَ بَنَيْنَاهَا بِأَيْدٍ
9:29	(the people with the book act according to it in return for) living in peace which it enables them to	عَنْ يَدٍ
25:27	to chew one's hands (one's fingernails) in anger	يَوْمَ يَعْضُ الظَّالِمُ عَلَى يَدَيْهِ
2:95	all that their hands have sent before them (effects of their deeds as per the Law of requital)	بِمَا قَدَّمْتِ أَيْدِيَهُمْ
2:195	do not destroy yourself with your hands	وَلَا تُلْقُوا بِأَيْدِيكُمْ إِلَى التَّهْلُكَةِ

49:1	In reference to orders and decisions	لَا تُقَدِّمُوا بَيْنَ يَدَيِ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ
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For explanations regarding cutting of the hands of a thief, see heading (**Q-Th-Ain**), and “يَدِ بَيْضَاءَ” (*yadi baiza*) in the heading (**B-Y-Zd**) and (**Zd-M-M**).

Y-S-R

ی س ر

“الْيَسْرُ” (*al-yasar*), “الْيُسْرُ” (*al-yusr*): softness.

“الْيُسْرُ” (*al-yusr*): ease, abundance, the abundance of comforts, strength, well-being economically. It is the opposite of “عُسْرُ” (*usr*) which means “paucity” {*T*}.

“يَسِرَ” (*yasira*) and “يَسُرُ الْأَمْرَ” (*yasuril amr*): the matter became easy, made the work or matter easy.

“يَسَرَ” (*yassara*): made this issue easy

“تَيَسَّرَ” (*tayassara*), “اسْتَيْسَرَ” (*astaisar*): became easy, became available easily {*T*} (73:20, 2:296).

Ibn Faris says it basically means “to open and be easy”.

“الْيَسَارُ” (*al-yasaar*): left hand, to the left side. It is the opposite of “يَمِينٌ” (*yameen*) {*T*}.

“الْيَيْسِرُ” (*al-yaseer*) and “الْمَيْسُورُ” (*al-yasoor*): easy, small thing {*T*}.

“الْمَيْسَرَةُ” (*al-maisaratu*) and “الْيَسَارُ” (*al-yasaar*): strength, well-being, free from need {*R*} (2:280).

“الْمَيْسِرُ” (*al-maisir*): gamble, chance, the camel which is won or lost in gambling {*T*}.

The Quran has used “يُسْرُ” (*yusr*) against “عُسْرُ” (*usr*) in (2:185).

Surah **Bani Israel** says:

17:27	talk to them politely (softly)	فَقُلْ لَهُمْ قَوْلًا مَّيْسُورًا
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Surah **Al-Ahzaab** says “يَسِيرًا” (*yaseera*) in (33:14) which means “at least, very few, few in number, for some time or few in number”.

Surah **Al-Baqrah** says about drinking and gambling:

2:219	There is a great sin and some benefit in both of them for the people, the sin in both is far greater than the benefit.	فِيهِمَا إِتْكَبِيرٌ وَمَنْافِعٌ لِلنَّاسِ وَإِنَّهُمَا أَكْبَرُ مِنْ نَفْعِهِمَا
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“مَيْسِرُ” (*maisirun*), has come from “يُسْرُ” (*yusr*) which basically means “ease”. Although the Arabs call every type of gambling “مَيْسِرُ” (*maisar*), but if it is not confined to the particular type of gambling which is played by arrows in a certain manner and in which a camel’s meat was divided accordingly (win or lose), then it would mean any wealth or riches that a man gets easily.

Although this type of wealth that is acquired easily is generally welcomed, it produces laziness and slackens the will to work. See heading (**A-T-M**). Such earnings are more hurtful in the long run than the benefits derived. Therefore, this sort of wealth has been forbidden to acquire.

As such it has been called “رَجْسٌ مِنْ عَمَلِ الشَّيْطَانِ” (*rijsoon min amalish shaitaan*), that is, “a work of the devil” (5:90). This has been said to be a hurdle in the system of *salaat* advocated by the Quran (5:91). The Quran teaches that a man should earn through his efforts, and whatever is more than his needs, should be made available for the sustenance of others (2:219).

Obviously wealth, if acquired easily without much effort, will make a man habitual of such effortless acquisition and will thus weaken his abilities as the human Self develops when it participates actively in meeting the challenges of life. The easily acquired wealth increases the lust for more wealth, and instead of sharing it with others, man is always trying to grab whatever he can for himself, like any gambler wishes to do. Therefore any wealth that is acquired without much effort is “مَيْسِرُ” (*maisar*). Under the

capitalist system most large businesses are based on the exploitation of the labour class especially those in the so called developing world and actually comes under “مَيْسَر” (*maisar*). If one goes deep into the basic meaning then he will find that the entire capitalist system is “مَيْسَر” (*maisar*). In this system every man endeavours to reap the benefits of the work of others and those at the lower end of the society become poorer with every passing day. This is the state of the world as we see it today.

The Quran has said that if you want to acquire real ease and comfort in life, then face difficulties:

94:5	Indeed, in hardship, there is ease	إِنَّ مَعَ الْعُسْرِ يُسْرًا
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The individual or nation which is shy of facing difficulties can never really acquire ease which creates real happiness, although he can attain “يُسْر” (*yusr*), i.e. “easy money” which makes it habitual of laziness and weakness and which ultimately leads to self-destruction.

Yaqoob يعقوب

Ibrahim’s son was *Ishaq* and his son was *Yaqoob*. Allah has mentioned him among the messengers.

2:136	And We gave the revelation to <i>Ibrahim</i> and <i>Ismail</i> and <i>Is-haaq</i> and <i>Yaqoob</i>	وَمَا أَنزَلْنَا إِلَىٰ إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْمَاعِيلَ وَإِسْحَاقَ وَيَعْقُوبَ
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His (*Yaqoob*’s) title was *Israeel* (man of Allah) and his descendants were called *Bani Israel* (descendants of *Israel*).

Surah *Aal-e-Imraan* says:

3:92	Except of which Israel had forbidden for themselves	إِلَّا مَا حَرَّمَ إِسْرَائِيلُ عَلَىٰ نَفْسِهِ
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Surah *Maryam* says:

19:58	The progeny from <i>Ibrahim</i> and <i>Israeel</i>	مِنْ ذُرِّيَّةِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْرَائِيلَ
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Yusuf was his son.

Ya’ooq يَعْقُوقُ

This was the name of an idol of the nation of *Noah* (71:23). The Arabs were well familiar with this name. The tribe of *Banu Hamdaan* used to worship an idol of this name as well.

Yaghoos يَغُوثُ

It was also an idol of the nation of *Noah* (71:23) and the Arabs were familiar with this name as well. The tribe of *Banu Murad* used to worship an idol of this name.

Yaqteen يَقْطِينُ

“الْيَقْطِينُ” (*al-yaqteen*): a vine which spreads out on the ground, like that of melons, gourds, etc. Some say that “يَقْطِينُ” (*yaqteen*) means a gourd vine, and also that “يَقْطِينَةٌ” (*yaqteenah*) means gourd {*T, M, R*}.

Taj-ul-Uroos says that a plant with the life of one year is called “يَقْطِينُ” (*yaqteen*) and that every big leaf is called “يَقْطِينُ” (*yaqteen*).

The Quran says:

37:146	a plant with short leaves but which provides shade	شَجَرَةً مِنْ يَتُّطِينَ
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“الْيَقَظَةُ” (*al-yaqzha*): awakening. It is the opposite of “نَوْمٌ” (*naum*) which means “sleep”. It has the connotation of astuteness (being wide awake).
 “رَجُلٌ يَقْظٌ” (*rajulun yaqizu*), “يَقْظٌ” (*yaqa'iz*): a man awake. Its plural is “أَيَقَظُ” (*ai-qaaz*) as against “رُقُودٌ” (*raqud*) (18:18).
 “أَبُو الْيَقْظَانِ” (*abul yaqzaan*): a rooster (the masculine of hen) {T}.

“يَقِينُ الْأَعْمَرَ” (*yaqinal amra*), “أَيَقَنَهُ” (*aiqanahu*), “أَسْتَيْقَنَهُ” (*astaiqanahu*), “تَيَقَّنَهُ” (*tayaqqanah*): he came to know about the matter and found out the truth about it.
 “يَقْنُ” (*yaqnun*), “يَقَنُ” (*yaqan*): for some matter to be evident and proven.
 “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*): it is the opposite of doubt, i.e. for doubts to be removed and to be proven as true {T}.
 Death too is called “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*) because every living being has to face it, and daily events give testimony to this {T}.

Surah *Al-Anaam* says about *Ibrahim*:

6:67	He reached the truth after observing the universal laws	مَلَكُوتِ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ
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Surah *Al-Hijr* says:

15:99	You continue following the laws given by your Provider till your claims (that following this system will prove very rewarding) are proven as a truth	وَأَعْبُدْ رَبَّكَ حَتَّى يَأْتِيَكَ الْيَقِينُ
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Thus “إِيمَانٌ” (*imaan*) would mean “to trust someone that he is telling the truth” and “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*) would mean “for it to be proven as palpable truth” (74:47).

102:6	you will see it as a proven fact	لَتَرَوُنَّهَا عَيْنَ الْيَقِينِ
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The Quran says that the *momineen* have “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*) on the “آخِرَت” (*aakhirah*). This means that they have faith on the future results of their deeds (2:3). When they establish this system (of Allah), these results are factually made evident. This way their “إِيمَانٌ” (*imaan*) turns to “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*) (2:2). This is what belief or faith in the “آخِرَت” (*aakhirah*) means. This way man travels from “إِيمَانٌ” (*imaan*) to “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*) and has faith that in the life “آخِرَت” (*aakhirat*) too is a reality.

The distinction drawn between “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*) and “إِيمَانٌ” (*imaan*) is only for the convenience of readers to understand the two terms otherwise “إِيمَانٌ” (*imaan*) is another name for “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*), and “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*) cannot be produced without “إِيمَانٌ” (*imaan*). These two words are alternatives to express the same inner state of a momin: or one can say that “يَقِينُ” (*yaqeen*) takes birth when the “إِيمَانُ” (*imaan*) is proven by the results:

“الْيَمَامُ” (*al-yamaam*): to intend {T, M}.
 “الْيَمُّ” (*al-yumm*): river. It also means sea {T, M} (28:40, 28:7, 20:39).
 “النَّيْمُ” (*an-nayammum*): to intend to do something, to intend {T, M} (5:6, 4:43, 2:267).
 Also see heading (*M-S-He*).

“الْيَمْنُ” (*al-yumn*): profusion, not physically but in effect.

“الْمَيْمَنَةُ” (*al-maimanah*): profusion towards the right side.

“الْيَمَانُ” (*al-yaman*): on the right side.

“الْيَمِينُ” (*al-yameen*): right hand, on the right side. It also means “strength” {R}.

“يَمِينٌ” (*yameen*): to promise or to swear. The plural is “أَيْمَانٌ” (*aimaan*). The Arabs used to strike their right hand over the other when they swore {T, M}.

Surah *Al-Kahaf* says:

18:18	On their right and their left sides	ذَاتِ الْيَمِينِ وَذَاتِ الشَّامِلِ
28:30	From the corner of the blessed valley (or from the right corner of the valley)	مِنْ شَاطِئِ الْوَادِ الْأَيْمَنِ

To mean “oath” the word “أَيْمَانُكُمْ” (*aimaanukum*) has been used in (2:224).

For “marriage” the words “عَقَدْتُ أَيْمَانُكُمْ” (*a’qadat aimaanukum*) has been used in (4:33).

To mean “blessing”, the words “أَصْحَابُ الْيَمِينِ” (*ashaabil yameen*) have been used in (56:27), and also “أَصْحَابُ الْمَيْمَنَةِ” (*ashaabul maimanah*) in (56:8), but they can also mean “those on the right side”.

“الطُّورِ الْأَيْمَنِ” (*at-tooril aiman*): power (19:52).

Surah *As-Sa’affaat* says:

37:93	<i>Ibrahim</i> struck the statues (idols) with full might or power	فَرَأَى عَلَيْهِمْ ضَرْبًا بِالْيَمِينِ
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In the same surah a little earlier it is said:

37:28	they will say that you used to come to us with tremendous strength and means (and thus used to prevent us from adopting the path of the truth)	قَالُوا إِنَّكُمْ كُنْتُمْ تَأْتُونَنَا عَنِ الْيَمِينِ
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At several places the Quran has said “مَا مَلَكَتْ أَيْمَانُكُمْ” (*ma malakat aimaanukum*). Literally it means “whose possessors”. At some places this phrase means “those who are your subordinates or under you” as in (4:36). But at other places it means “slaves” and “slave-girls”.

Surah *An-Noor* says:

24:33	Those slaves of yours who enter a pact in writing with you (enter into a pact for their freedom)	وَالَّذِينَ يَبْتِغُونَ الْكِتَابَ بِمَا مَلَكَتْ أَيْمَانُكُمْ
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Before Islam’s advent slavery prevailed in the Arab culture. Slaves used to work outside the home and slave-girls within. This was the society in which Islam made its advent. When the Arabs turned to *Islam* they had these slaves and slave-girls. Islam had made its appearance to free mankind but if it advocated freedom for all slaves (who were present in the society at that time) at once, then this would have created imbalance in the society as these freed human beings had nowhere to go to earn a living. Young women in such large numbers without husbands (the slave-girls), if let loose in a society, would certainly create chaos and would have given rise to more corruption in the society. Therefore *Islam* didn’t order them all to be freed from bondage at once, but closed the door to any more slavery for ever. At the same time it gave such orders for slaves and the slave girls then present in the society, that they would gradually induct as free men and women in the society as respectable equal human beings. Till they did so, they would be treated humanely. Whatever has been referred in the Quran under this term “مَا مَلَكَتْ أَيْمَانُكُمْ” (*ma malakat aimaanukum*) has been said about these slaves and slave women. Thereafter, the door to further slavery was closed – the Quran at a fundamental level does not want any human being to be subservient to any other human being at a Self level (82:19).

Therefore there was no further need for these orders, although if a situation arises again in the future like when a nation accepts Islam and comes out of paganism, then the orders about slaves and slave-women would also apply to them.

As per the above meanings of “مَامَلَكْتَ أَيْمَانُكُمْ” (*ma malakat aimanukum*) if we view various places in the Quran where the phrase has appeared, it will become clear that these orders are for the slaves and slave-girls of that time, and that’s all (not for all times).

7:29	those who protect their chastity or go only to those	وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يُغْرَوْهُمْ حِفْظُونَ الْأَعْلَىٰ أَرْوَاجِهِمْ
7:30	women (for having sex) whom they possess	أَوْ مَامَلَكْتَ أَيْمَانُهُمْ

Everywhere this subject has cropped up, the past tense has been used.
For more details, see heading (*M-L-K*).

It is unfortunate that *Muslim* rulers in the past found it a convenient way to open the door to slavery and presented these verses of the Quran as an argument in support of their deeds.

Y-N-Ain ي ن ع

“يَنْعَ النَّمْرُ” (*yana’as-samar*), “يَنْعُ” (*yain a’u*), “يَنْعَا” (*yan’a*): for the fruit to ripen and be ready for picking.
“الْيَنْيَعُ” (*al-yanih*): fully ripened fruit.
“الْيَانِعُ” (*al-yaani’u*): mature red fruit {*T, M*}.

The Quran says:

6:100	The ripening of the fruit (for it to become red due to ripening)	وَ يَنْعِهِ
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Yahood يهود

This is the other name of the nation of *Bani Israel*.
For details, see heading “*Moosa*” and heading (*He-W-D*).

Yusuf يوسف

Ibrahim was the father of *Ishaq*, his son was *Yaqoob* and his son was *Yusuf*.

The Quran has mentioned the story about him in a single Surah. No other messenger’s story has been related in such detail in one go. In childhood his brothers had put him in an abandoned well (12:15). From there, a caravan took him to Egypt. Thereafter going through various stages, he became the leader of that nation in an authoritative way (12:56, 12:101).

He brought over his family, kith and kin to live with him in Egypt. In this way, the *Bani Israel* i.e. descendants of *Yaqoob* shifted to Egypt from *Kan’aan*. Surah *Al-Anaam* mentions *Yusuf* while speaking of other messengers (6:85) and in Surah *Al-Momin* a *momin* man of the court of the Pharaoh describes *Yusuf* as a messenger (40:34). This shows that *Yusuf* had communicated his message (about Allah’s system) to the nation of Egypt.

The story of *Yusuf*’s life and his wonderful characteristics can be found the book titled ‘*Jooy-e-Noor*’.

“يَوْمٌ” (*yoom*): day, the time from sunrise to sunset. This word is used by the Arabs to mean a certain time or era. There is no distinction in it for day or night, morning or evening. It could mean “one year” or “a century”, “a thousand years” or even “fifty thousand years”. Like with “وَقْتُ” (*waqt*) and “سَاعَةٌ” (*saa’at*), after “يَوْمٌ” (*yoom*), “إِذْ” (*iz*) is added and “يَوْمَئِذٍ” (*yaumaizin*) almost means the same thing as “وَقْتُئِذٍ” (*waqtaizin*) and “سَاعَتِئِذٍ” (*saataizin*) {T, M}.

So, “وَقْتُ” (*waqt*), “سَاعَةٌ” (*saa’a*) and “يَوْمٌ” (*yoom*) are nearly of the same meaning, i.e. “time period”. The plural of “يَوْمٌ” (*yoom*) is “أَيَّامٌ” (*ayyaam*) {T, M}.

Ibn Faris says “يَوْمٌ” (*yoom*) means “day” and he has also said that figuratively it means “a great thing”.

It also means “government”, “power” and “wealth” {R}.

3:140	And we alternate these <i>ayyam</i> among the people	تِلْكَ الْأَيَّامُ نُدَاوِلُهَا بَيْنَ النَّاسِ
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Here “أَيَّامٌ” (*ayyam*) means government and state {R}.

“أَيَّامُ الْعَرَبِ” (*ayyam*) also appears to mean “the great and unforgettable events of history”, like “أَيَّامُ الْعَرَبِ” (*ayyamul Arb*) which means “the era of the Arabs” {R}. At various places in the Quran (*ayyamul-laah*) has come to mean this.

14:5	And remind them of the <i>ayyam</i> of Allah	وَذَكِّرْهُمْ بِأَيَّامِ اللَّهِ
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For the confrontation between the Pharaoh and *Moosa*, it has been said that these “أَيَّامُ اللَّهِ” (*ayyamul-laah*) occurred because:

45:14	So that a nation was punished for its (evil) deeds	لِيَجْزِيَ قَوْمًا بِمَا كَانُوا يَكْسِبُونَ
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Therefore some scholars say that “أَيَّامٌ” (*ayyam*) means “the results of bad deeds” and “punishments” too {T}.

The evolution as created by Allah continues unbridled in the universe. About this the Quran says that when Allah, according to His will wants to bring forth some scheme, then He creates a complete blueprint for this plan in the world of *amr*. Then its implementation begins from the lowest stage:

Then that scheme rises up by going through its evolutionary stages. These stages are completed in “يَوْمٌ” (*yooms*) which according to man’s calculations could be a thousand years long:

32:5	Then it will ascend to him in a day which will have the length of a thousand years of your count	ثُمَّ يَرْجِعُ إِلَيْهِ فِي يَوْمٍ كَانَ مِقْدَارُهُ أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ مِمَّا تَعُدُّونَ
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Obviously here “يَوْمٌ” (*yoom*) means either stage or era or evolutionary period. This “يَوْمٌ” (*yoom*) is sometime fifty thousand years long as noted in (70:4). Researchers about evolution are better qualified to testify as to how long these evolutionary periods are.

Therefore, wherever the word “يَوْمٌ” (*yoom*) is used in the Quran, it will not mean “a day” which is only 24 hours long. The meaning would be “time”, or “period”, or “era”, or some “stage”:

1:3	The era when all opponents (of Islam) are defeated and only the laws of Allah enjoy supremacy and dominance	مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ
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Or this would mean “the era in which the results of men are compiled as per justice”, or “the time of manifestation of results”.

82:19	the era when predominance will only be to Allah's laws	وَالْأَمْرُ لِلَّهِ يُؤْمِنُ اللَّهُ
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For more details, see heading **(D-Y-N)**.

Yunus

يونس

Yunus is among the messengers of **Bani Israel**. His Hebrew name was **Jonah** which in Arabic became **Yunus**. The **Torah** mentions his story in the **Book of Jonah**.

His time is guessed to have been around 700 BC.

The Quran says:

37:139	Indeed Yunus was from among the messengers	إِنَّ يُونُسَ لَمِنَ الْمُرْسَلِينَ
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In the **Torah** (in the Book of Jonah) there are details about him, but against the usual style of the **Torah**, it contains things about him which are not befitting a messenger. The Quran has only said that he became disappointed with his nation and came out intending to go somewhere other than that place and on the way boarded some boat. The boat was entrapped in some whirlpool. The sailors probably decided to throw some boarders into the sea (to lighten the boat and save most of the passengers). He too was thrown into the river where a big fish swallowed him, but ultimately he survived and reached the shore. See (37:139-146), (21:87-88).

Messengers have generally migrated to a place more conducive to their missions if their present place of abode was found not conducive to their mission. But this migration took place only when told to do so under Allah's orders. It seems that **Yunus** migrated from his nation at his own accord, i.e. his decision to do so was not in compliance to Allah's orders. It was before time. Therefore later he repented this decision (37:142).

Messenger **Muhammed** was warned not to be like the "Fish Man" (68:28) i.e. like **Yunus**. Also see heading **(A-B-Q)**.

The Quran has also said that the dwelling **Nainwa**, which he was sent to as a Messenger had a population of over one hundred thousand. In other words it was a very big city of those times. The residents of **Nainwa** initially denied his invitation to accept **Islam**, but later accepted **Islam** and so avoided the punishment which would have befallen them if they had not (37:148). The residents managed to avoid destruction a bit by doing this, but after some time (in nearly 690 BC) they returned to the previous path again. Another messenger of the **Bani Israel**, whom the Quran has not mentioned but who is mentioned in the traditions of the Jews, warned them of the punishment from or wrath of God. They did not desist and as a result they were attacked on one side by the Babylonians and on the other they faced a big flood, and so the city of **Nainwa** was destroyed.

The Quran has called him "ذَا النُّونَ" (**zan-nun**) in (21:87) and also as "صَاحِبِ الْحُوتِ" (**ashaab-il-huut**).

Lillah-il-hamd

Thanks to Allah, ***Lughat-ul-Quran*** is hereby completed.

Thanks to Allah that by its completion the labour of my life has been protected in this book. I guess that in the presence of the ***Lughat-ul-Quran*** there will be no difficulty in comprehending the Quran.

This, however, is a human endeavour which is subject to errors. I have laid a foundation in comprehending the Quran and others can improve it.

Reflection and deliberation in the Quran can never end, and therefore there can be no last human word in this context.

Ghulam Ahmad Parwez.